전지적
독자시점
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# OMNISCIENT READER'S VIEWPOINT

**[SEQUEL]**

**Sing Shong 싱숑**

**Art By Black Box 검넴 (@1L9l2Aa8UCL0IGJ)**

This EPUB is based on the Fan translation available at: https://orv.pages.dev

This translation has been a collaborative project, worked on and edited by **multiple community members** to ensure quality and consistency.

For a full list of those who contributed to the ORV Reader web project, please refer to the contributor list on GitHub: ORV-Reader Contributors

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**Feedback and Corrections**

If you find any errors, typos, or translation issues, then please help report them on our Discord server.

discord.gg/CZdNvKaNNr

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The EPUB was tested using the following readers, which are recommended:

- Moon Reader
- Calibre

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전지적
독자시점
싱숑 현대 판타지 소설

# 553 Prologue. Side Story Notice

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Everyone, thank you for waiting for so long.

Finally, we begin the side story of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

I've started it, but honestly, I have no idea what to write. This story was never written with a spin-off in mind in the first place.

While I was taking a break, I read the comments fans left on the main story, and I was truly surprised.

You guys are geniuses. On the other hand, I can't seem to come up with a single thing. How thoughtless of me… In fact, I haven’t even decided on a main character yet.

When I was writing ORV, the words flowed smoothly, but now my mind is a complete blank—as if someone had struck me hard on the back of the head.

Nevertheless, the reason I am writing this notice is because I feel I should at least say something.

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After writing that much, I stopped typing and held down the backspace key.

Damn it, what am I doing? No matter how desperate the situation, this isn't how a professional writer should speak.

I bit my nails and tried to craft a new sentence.

How about starting like this?

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Come to think of it, I've never formally introduced myself. My identity was technically revealed in chapter 549 of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, but I'm sure you've all forgotten by now.

To put it in Kim Dokja's terms, I am this kind of person:

Lee Hakhyun (李鶴翾).

My father, wishing for me to fly like a noble crane, paid a hefty sum of 300,000 won to a Philosophy Hall to give me that name.

The crane's wings are spread wide[1]. (학 학(鶴)에 날 현(翾).)

[NOTE 1]

The Philosophy Hall[2] that named me went bankrupt shortly after. It was only then that my father discovered the parentheses hidden in front of the character "翾," which means "to fly (lightly)."

[NOTE 2]

In short, my life was defined by this: Lee Hakhyun, 33 years old, a (lightly) successful web novel author.

By the way, the name of my only hit is:

> **[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint - Total 551 Chapters]**
>
> —Author Lee Hakhyun

A long-form fantasy novel consisting of 551 chapters, 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』—abbreviated as "ORV."

I spent two years of my life on this story, from my late 20s into my early 30s…

.

.

.

After writing that much, I hit backspace again.

I just introduced myself, and it felt even worse. What's the point of introducing myself when I'm not even the protagonist of this side story?

Tsutsutsu.

That wasn't the sound of a probability spark. It was my cell phone vibrating.

I pressed the call button with a grim expression, feeling like Kim Dokja preparing for a massive storm of probability aftermath. Then, I heard the voice of the dokkaebi in charge.

—Author-nim.

This was currently my second most feared word.

"Yes."

—Are you working on the side story?

And that was the first.

“No.”

The person sighing on the other end of the line was Ji Eunyu, my dedicated editor.

To be blunt, Ji Eunyu is a veteran producer in this industry. If I’m being honest, she’s the one who dragged me—a man who used to write pure literature—into this world. In that sense, she was a lifesaver.

—What do you plan to do?

I answered in a hollow voice.

“That’s the question. What should I do?”

—You’re not playing a game right now, are you? That new one that just launched?

“I only just installed it.”

—Then why are you showing as 'online' on Steam?

“It... launches automatically when I boot up the computer.”

—Really? Because I just got a notification that you started a session.

I quickly shut down the game as it was loading.

“Do you think I’m playing just for fun? I’m playing to gather ideas.”

—I used to believe that. I really did.

Ji Eunyu has a theory she’s developed over six years as an editor:

Writers who play games for 'inspiration' will keep playing long after the inspiration arrives.

Honestly, I couldn't argue with that.

—What about that idea you mentioned before?

“When I actually sat down to write it, it fell apart.”

—You said you wanted to connect it with your previous works. We discussed it briefly, remember?

I recalled the titles of my past failures one by one.

『The Orc Philosopher』

『Infinite Instructor』

『System Breaker』

『The Wizard of the Undying World』

『Method Master』

『How to Become a Star Writer』

…

No matter how I looked at it, there was no natural way to blend those stories with ORV.

Besides, 『How to Become a Star Writer』 was an absurd tale about a writer named Lee Hakhyun (yes, me) getting trapped inside a novel to become a “star writer.” There was no way I could use that for a collaboration.

And above all—

“Why would I collaborate with a failure?”

Most of those novels were axed before they even reached a paid model.

—I enjoyed them all, though.

“Hearing that doesn't comfort me at all.”

—You mentioned getting drunk on the rooftop once and having an epiphany. Can’t you try that again?

“I already tried.”

—Well... do you feel any tingling in the back of your head? Does Han Sooyoung appear in your dreams?

I sighed, caught between a laugh and a sob.

In the novel, Yoo Joonghyuk would hit me in the back of the head, Han Sooyoung would send me the manuscript, and I would write it all perfectly... but reality isn't like that. These days, I almost wish it were true.

—Ugh, I'm sorry.

I knew why she said it. Ji Eunyu was just as frustrated as I was.

The news is full of reports about the market downturn. I heard Ji Eunyu's management firm is also struggling financially. Employees are leaving, and their contracted writers are jumping ship or quitting the industry entirely.

I wondered if me writing a side story would even make a difference in a mess like this.

—Anyway, there are still many readers waiting for your story, Author-nim.

"Where are they?"

It's embarrassing to admit, but "ORV" once held the number one spot on the platform's free bestseller list. It had its glory days.

There were readers who genuinely liked my work, and discussions used to pop up in various communities.

Back when I was still serializing, I would secretly search for "Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint" and smile at the readers' reactions.

But that's all in the past now.

No one remembers my novel anymore.

—Stop being so cynical. They exist.

Then where?

I swallowed the question before it could escape.

"I'll try my best."

After hanging up, I decided I needed a drink.

I closed my laptop and headed to a nearby convenience store for a beer and some snacks. I reached for the potato chips, but hesitated, eventually swapping them for a protein biscuit.

Am I at the age where I have to worry about my health now?

As I sipped the beer, Ji Eunyu's words echoed in my mind.

「"There are many readers waiting for Author-nim's story."」

For the record, the single brackets (「」) are symbols I use when I'm having a significant thought. And I'm having one right now.

Are there really readers still waiting for me?

I finished the beer and logged into the web novel platform.

A mountain of notifications awaited me. System messages urging me to resume serialization, and notes from other writers announcing their new projects.

And then…

—I enjoyed reading this, Author-nim.

Messages from readers.

—I'm a 14-year-old in middle school this year. This was the first web novel I ever read ㅜㅜ…

Some were cute, others were deeply sincere.

—Reading this novel is the only joy of my life in the military…

They were fragments of stories left for me by those who had read my work.

Three years have passed since then.

The middle schoolers must be in high school now. The high schoolers are in college, the soldiers have been discharged, and the job seekers have hopefully found their way… I hope.

Either way, those readers moved on to become 'something' else, while I'm still here—a boring man choosing protein biscuits over chips.

—It was fun, Author-nim.

I felt a sudden pang in my chest and spilled a bit of beer.

A new notification light was blinking. It was a message that had just arrived.

Who would send a message to an author three years after a story ended?

—Sender: RepresentativeKimDokja.

As soon as I saw the ID, a memory surfaced.

RepresentativeKimDokja.

During the height of the serialization, there was a reader with that exact nickname.

—It's been three years since ORV ended. Every year around this time, I come back to binge-read it, and I enjoyed it just as much this year. It's strange; the novel feels different every time I read it.

The memories of three years ago felt vivid. They really did love the story back then.

That was what I wanted to say.

This reader had left comments every single day and sent messages of encouragement after every milestone.

In short, he was the living embodiment of the name "RepresentativeKimDokja."

—I don't know if you remember me.

Of course I do. I can still see the old messages.

I remember writing until the very last second of every deadline, then reading these messages and comments with an exhausted body before finally collapsing into sleep.

If it weren't for the people who endured that time with me, I never would have survived that loneliness. I never would have reached the final sentence.

I hesitated for a moment before reaching for the keyboard. This time, I wanted to reply not as a novelist, but with my own voice.

However.

—There will be a small fan event tomorrow at 7 PM. If you have time, please come. I've prepared a special gift for you as a thank you.

A gift?

—Sorry, but there is an admission fee for the event. I have to make a living too, after all.

At that moment, the prologue of ORV flashed through my mind.

In that prologue, Kim Dokja receives a message from the author, tls123, saying the epilogue will be released for a fee.

It seemed this reader was playing a small, nostalgic joke on me.

I started typing my reply.

—Thank you so much, Reader-nim. But I'll accept the gift in spirit only. Also, if there's an admission fee… isn't that a gift I'm technically paying for? (hahaha)

There was no way they had actually prepared a real gift, right?

Even if they had, I couldn't bring myself to accept it. How could I be so shameless when I haven't been able to write a single word of a side story in three years?

By the way, should I delete the (hahaha)? Do people still use that?

I was naively sipping my beer and worrying about trivial things like that, completely unaware of how my life was about to change the very next day.

---

Author's Note:

This is the Side Story of "Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint," yet it does not exist outside the main story.

This is still the story of Kim Dokja, but it is not for only one Kim Dokja.

Thank you for waiting.

Once again, let us begin "Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint."

(February 2023, Singsong)

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: It refers to a person’s skills and talents reaching their full potential. Just as a crane spreads its wings to soar, it implies one's talents are finally unfolding.

Note [2]: Philosophy Hall (철학관): A traditional Korean establishment for fortune-telling and naming based on Saju.

# 554 Episode 1. The World After The End (1)

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「This is a story about despair that was not read.」

---

After receiving that interesting message yesterday, something surprising happened to me.

I wrote the first sentence of the side story.

I can't tell you what the first sentence is. It's a spoiler, and it's not really a great sentence.

But it might have a pretty good meaning someday. It was the same when I wrote the first sentence of ORV.

The whole story starts with Ji Eunyu's sudden visit around lunchtime today.

"Author-nim, let's go somewhere together."

I was grabbed by the scruff of my neck and got into a taxi, and it didn't take even an hour to get to our destination.

The place we finally arrived at was in front of a theater in Chungmuro. It was a place that had once been used as the background for "ORV."

I stared at the placard posted at the entrance of the theater. Judging by the name, it was definitely an event related to “ORV.”

I suddenly remembered the message I received from “RepresentativeKimDokja” yesterday.

—There will be a small fan event tomorrow at 7 PM. If you have time, please come and enjoy it.

Could this be the one from yesterday?

I asked Ji Eunyu.

“How did you know about this?”

“The event organizer contacted us. He said he wanted to hold a paid event and wanted permission. Instead, he said he would donate all the admission fees to an orphanage under Kim Dokja’s name. I came just to keep an eye on it.”

That’s what the paid admission fee meant.

I nodded exaggeratedly and said.

“That’s good. But why am I—”

“Readers. You asked where they were.”

I belatedly remembered the phone call I had with Ji Eunyu yesterday. Ji Eunyu said that there were readers waiting for my novel, and I asked where they were.

I turned my head again and looked at the theater.

In that place, there were the readers Ji Eunyu had mentioned.

Suddenly, I felt blood rushing to my head and my heart started pounding.

“But is it okay for me to go in?”

Ji Eunyu tilted her head at my hesitation.

“Why?”

“I’m the writer.”

“It’s okay, Han Sooyoung wrote it.”

Seeing Ji Eunyu playfully respond, I also ended up laughing bitterly.

“That’s right.”

Well, what kind of writer is a writer who hasn’t written anything for three years?

Today, I wanted to pass all my burdens on to Han Sooyoung, whom I had never even seen. The reason I couldn’t write the side story was because Han Sooyoung didn’t write the manuscript in that distant universe, and Yoo Joonghyuk didn’t deliver it.

I wanted to believe that.

At the entrance of the theater, life-sized figures of ORV characters were on display. Judging from the design, they seemed to be drawn based on the style of the webtoon version that was once serialized. The quality was so great that I was amazed.

I admired the drawings while recalling the names of each character.

The Demon King of Salvation Kim Dokja, Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk, Black Flames Empress Han Sooyoung, Moonlight Empress Yoo Sangah, Judge of Destruction Jung Heewon, Steel Sword Emperor Lee Hyunsung, Beast Lord Shin Yoosung, Insect Lord Lee Gilyoung, and the Delusion Demon Kim Namwoon… Even the supporting characters with small screen time, such as the bald Gong Pildu, the doctor Lee Seolhwa, and the fake protagonist Jang Hayoung…

“Honestly, it’s better than what we made.”

Even Ji Eunyu answered like that.

Not only was the quality good, but the fact that they put so much effort into it was impressive in itself.

I also smiled bitterly and added,

“I would believe it even if the real webtoon artists drew it.”

“Isn’t this actually drawn by them?”

“No way. They all left after that incident.”

There was a time when “Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint” was also made into a webtoon.

It started off well. Great writers took charge of the composition and animation.

But unfortunately, before the 10th chapter was even serialized, a lightning strike struck the studio and a large fire broke out, and the company, unable to handle the aftermath, went bankrupt. On top of that, the management’s financial difficulties combined to make the “Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint” webtoon disappear from the world after 11 chapters.

“We don’t know yet, author-nim. If the side story goes well, the webtoon could be rebooted.”

It’s like Ji Eunyu to still be able to say such optimistic things.

“I gave up on those expectations a long time ago.”

After the webtoon failed, some kind of bad luck befell me, and strange things happened to all kinds of secondary works related to “Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint.” When a movie contract was signed, the production company went bankrupt, and when a figure or goods were produced, the factory went bankrupt.

After repeating this several times, there were no more offers coming in.

I paused for a moment and said,

“There must be a worldline somewhere where ORV didn’t fail.”

In that worldline, the webtoon would have been a hit, and there would have been a movie, a drama, and maybe even an anime. It’s not this worldline, but I still sometimes have dreams like that.

“I told you we haven’t failed yet.”

I looked around the remaining life-sized figures with Ji Eunyu, who was grumbling. The line of life-sized figures was quite long, and it had characters from Uriel and the Great Sage Heaven's Equal to somewhat non-mainstream figures like Han Myungoh on display.

But at the end of the life-sized figures, there was an unfamiliar figure standing.

Who is this?

It was a man with squinted eyes, but I couldn't guess who he was.

Did a narrow-eyed character appear in ORV?

If only the name was written down so I could know…

I thought about asking Ji Eunyu, but then stopped.

The writer has his own pride.

"Two people."

"Please write your nickname on this name tag and attach it to your left chest."

We received the name tags from the guide and entered the theater.

Fortunately, no one recognized that I was ORV's writer. That was natural, it wasn't written that I was ORV's writer on the name tag. I looked at Ji Eunyu's name tag.

[Genius Editor]

"Ji Eunyu-ssi."

I sat down in the back with Ji Eunyu, who pretended not to hear me. I could see the backs of the heads of the fans who had sat down here and there in front of us.

I was surprised again. All those people are our readers. In fact, aren't they people Ji Eunyu bought?

When I looked to the side, Ji Eunyu's eyes were wide open.

"If I count roughly, there are more than thirty people?"

Thirty. It seems like a small number, but it meant that the number of core fans who took the time to come here was thirty.

I nodded, suppressing the emotion welling up in me.

Kim Dokja, you're so great.

Since the event hadn't started yet, I could hear the voices of readers chatting away in front of me.

“Do you have an ‘NEP’? It’s really hard to get one these days.”

“Oh, I have that.”

“Awesome. What about the ‘BE’?”

“I bought it right away.”

“Then, do you have a ‘DF’ too?”

“I do have it… but strangely, my ‘DF’ is starting to lose its mind.”

[NOTE 1]

I couldn’t understand what they were talking about. It seems like they are exchanging slang only the veterans have.

We sat side by side and eavesdropped on the veterans’ talk.

“It’s already the twelfth time.”

“Didn’t the host say today is the last?”

“Yes.”

“There were really a lot of people before. It’s gotten much smaller.”

“That’s right. Everyone is leaving one by one.”

It seems that this unidentified Kim Dokja’s banquet is already hosted for the twelfth time. They say there were even more people before.

I thought there were already enough people now…

“Excuse me, can I sit here?”

I turned my head at the sudden question. A large man like Lee Hyunsung was standing shyly, pointing to the seat next to me.

I nodded.

“Oh, yes. Please sit down.”

“Thank you…”

As expected, the man who bowed his head had a name tag pinned to his chest.

[Judge Heewon]

He must have been a fan of Judge of Destruction Jung Heewon.

Since it had been a long time since I had last sat next to a stranger, I felt a bit nervous.

Ji Eunyu, who must have noticed the awkward atmosphere, spoke first.

“I guess you’re a fan of Jung Heewon.”

Judge Heewon nodded slightly.

“Yes…”

And then the silence continued.

Ji Eunyu poked my arm as if to tell me to talk about something. Usually, she would bring up a topic at such times. Since it had been so long since I had talked to a stranger, I couldn’t think of anything to say.

I opened my mouth as I thought about what Kim Dokja would talk about here.

“I like Heewon.”

“Oh, yes!”

It was nothing special, but as I looked at the man smiling brightly, I felt like we had already formed an important bond. We nodded our heads repeatedly like men who had become sworn brothers and thought about Jung Heewon together.

[NOTE 2]

Jung Heewon. What a good character. I made it.

Judge Heewon looked at the nickname on my name tag for a long time and asked.

“You, your nickname is interesting.”

“Thank you.”

“Do you have a favorite…”

“Um, I…”

I thought about it for a moment, but it was hard to choose one person.

As the silence grew longer, Judge Heewon thought he had made a mistake and quickly added.

“Oh, you could be all-chara, but I made a mistake…”

[NOTE 3]

I don’t know exactly what all-chara means, but I had a rough idea.

I nodded lightly and answered.

“Everyone is good, except for guys like Cheon Inho.”

In case you forgot, Cheon Inho is the name of the extra villain who dies in the beginning of ORV.

Judge Heewon also lowered his voice with a dark expression, as if he knew Cheon Inho.

“Cheon Inho, that bad guy.”

“He’s a bad guy.”

“That bastard should be torn to pieces.”

“Uh… right?”

“That bastard should be burned to death in hellfire.”

That was the end of our conversation.

The host appeared on the stage of the theater. He was wearing a black suit and a white coat.

“Hello, I’m Kim Dokja, the host.”

A light cheer rose from the audience. Although he covered his eyes with sunglasses, his outfit was quite similar to Kim Dokja’s.

Is it handmade? That’s also quite high quality.

Soon, the theater screen lit up, and the event began.

Soft background music played, followed by the font of the [Fourth Wall].

「And on the Fourth Wall, it was all written down.」

And slowly, the comments left by readers began to appear on the screen.

From the prologue to chapter 551, the comments left by readers themselves.

"Gasp, I wrote that!"

A girl fan sitting in the front row spoke softly. Everyone in the theater was looking at the comments together.

There were comments that received a lot of "likes," and some that were funny or novel. There were also comments that contained touching sentiments.

"That was when Kim Dokja first died, right?"

"Ugh, don't look at my comments! Take them down quickly!"

"This is stuffed with dark history."

My heart also fluttered as I read the old comments.

ORV was serialized for two years, and three years had passed since its conclusion.

The history that the readers of this world had built up over the course of five years.

I watched it a long time, speechless.

It was like a story from a distant myth being told by someone.

Photos from exhibitions planned by fans and subway advertisements celebrating the characters' birthdays came to mind one after another.

Someone muttered quietly while looking at an illustration of Kim Dokja that caught their eye.

"It's Kim Dokja's birthday."

"It really snowed in Seoul that day."

On the pure white screen, the readers' comments piled up. Between the lines, I could see the footprints of me and them walking together.

"You're glad you came, right?"

At Ji Eunyu's words, I nodded without realizing it.

「Perhaps I wrote so many sentences just to see this scenery.」

My heart raced again.

If I had the qualifications, I wanted to say something to these people. I wanted to write sentences for them without running away or giving up.

I wanted to challenge this story again.

「But can I do it?」

That was when I heard the host's voice.

"Now, here's a word from author-nim who joined us for this event!"

The readers in the audience looked at each other and murmured.

I was dazed for a moment then came to my senses.

"Author-nim?" Ji Eunyu whispered to me in surprise.

For a moment, my mind became complicated.

Could it be that Ji Eunyu had secretly planned a fan meeting?

However, the look in Ji Eunyu's eyes showed she had no idea this would happen.

When I looked at the stage, the host was smiling and looking this way.

Should I get up first?

The moment I pretended to cough in vain and got up with the feeling that "I can't help it," a person's face suddenly appeared on the screen.

—Ah, ah.

A tear mole on white skin. Jet-black bob hair tied back.

Even without explaining who she was, there was no one here who didn’t know her.

The real author of 『Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint』 was there.

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Author's Note

Hello, this is Singsong.

I'm glad to be able to greet you again.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: NEP = New Employee Package; BE = Black Edition; DF = Dokja Figure (독자 피규어, which can also translate to Reader Figure)

Note [2]: Peach Garden Oath (도원결의): A legendary oath of brotherhood from the Romance of the Three Kingdoms, symbolizing fraternal loyalty.

Note [3]: All-chara (올캐러): A slang term for fans who love all characters ("all" + "character").

# 555 Episode 1. The World After The End (2)

—Ah, ah. Microphone test.

Was this how the characters felt when they first saw Bihyung on the subway?

—Do you all hear me?

The woman on the screen was so similar to the Han Sooyoung I imagined that I got goosebumps.

Maybe I wasn't the only one who thought so, the other readers were also looking at the screen with their mouths open.

—There are still people who remember that guy’s story. Well, you were all Kim Dokja, too.

It was Han Sooyoung, perfect down to her rude way of speaking. It was probably made by applying deepfake technology, but whoever played her was really amazing.

But Han Sooyoung suddenly started saying strange things.

—I sent a short side story to the cloud a while ago, have you all read it?

What?

—Of course you saw it. I know. But this was just an appetizer. The real 'side story' will begin soon.

No, wait a minute. What if you say that when I don't have any chapter ready yet?

Give me the manuscript right now.

—So, I'll ask you to take care of me in the future. Finally, you get one question.

The readers who were staring at the screen looked at each other.

Han Sooyoung added.

—Please tell me where you bought Yoo Joonghyuk's boots, please tell me if Gilyoung eats grasshoppers or not, I don't know anything about this, so please take note in advance.

Someone sighed as if it was a pity.

Readers seemed to hesitate whether they could really ask questions.

Well, that's just a recorded video in the first place, so even if you ask a question, you won't get an answer.

But there was a person who raised her hand.

"Is Kim Dokja back to life?"

It was a small girl fan sitting in the front row.

A brief silence fell over the room.

A question that any reader who has read the final chapter would be curious about.

In a sense, everyone knows the answer, so it's a question that can't be answered.

I felt sad. If Han Sooyoung in that video is really Han Sooyoung, she will feel the same as me.

However.

—Oh, yeah. You mean Kim Dokja, right?

What?

—That's...

Was it a real-time video?

And the next moment, the screen turned off with a tsutsutsu sound.

An exclamation came from the audience.

"Oh, unfortunately, the signal was cut off. Let's check whether Kim Dokja is alive or not in the side story together!"

Indeed, the host's skillful hosting was at a level comparable to Kim Dokja's.

I could hear readers chatting with excitement.

"Is a side story really coming out?"

“I don’t think it was ever announced separately.”

Of course. Because I've never actually announced it.

Ji Eunyu, who was sitting next to me, whispered playfully.

"Isn't it a cute threat to start serializing it soon?"

"No, but that's too earnest."

While I let out a light sigh, the host was introducing the final segment.

"Then it’s time for today's last event, the ORV quiz. We’ve prepared enough prizes so that everyone can be rewarded equally, so if you get a question right, please come up to the stage right away."

Looking at the readers’ eyes shining, it seemed that this was the main event.

The host standing in front of the screen read the question.

"The first question is—"

After reading the question, the readers raised their hands. It was unexpected. I thought it was a pretty difficult question.

When the designated reader gave his answer, the host clapped his hands.

"Congratulations. Please come this way."

The reader with a flushed face was guided by the host and entered the curtain behind the screen.

After a while, the reader's presence disappeared with a tsutsutsu sound.

I laughed, and so did the readers.

It's an interesting directing.

Let's try to guess it this time.

"Now, the second question. How many times did ■ appear in the whole 'ORV'?

Ahem...

No matter how much I thought about it, I wondered who would know that.

Even I, the writer, don't know.

But there was a person who raised their hand.

"Me! The answer is—”

The reader raised their hand and started talking. Of course, I thought they were saying any number, but surprisingly, the host clapped his hands.

"Congratulations. Please come this way."

How on earth did you get it right?

The reader who correctly answered the second question also disappeared inside the curtain after being guided by the host.

The host said with a smile.

"Are the questions too difficult? This time it's an easy question!"

I focused on the host's words.

Okay, this time for sure.

"Third question. In 'Ways of Survival', Yoo Joonghyuk regresses 1,863 times. What does the number '1,863' symbolize here?

I was stunned for a moment after hearing the question.

What symbol was there in that number?

I guessed for what purpose ORV's author used the number 1,863.

I think... The author had no intention. It's definitely the case. I know it well because I'm the author of ORV.

This time, there were quite a lot of readers who raised their hands.

When the host pointed to someone, the reader spoke.

"1,863 is the year when the world's first subway opened, symbolizing that Yoo Joonghyuk's repeated regressions circle back to the subway."

What?

I thought, 'That can't be true,' but the readers around me agreed.

"Oh, that's right, that's right. It was that."

"Ah, I saw it in RepresentativeKimDokja's analysis article."

As the host clapped his hands, the reader who had given the answer went up to the stage with a smile.

Ji Eunyu asked me,

"Did 1,863 really have that meaning?"

"Of course. In what I wrote, every single number has meaning. Every element is connected in an amazing way."

The quiz continued.

Some questions were about things I knew, and for some I didn't know the answer at all.

However, as words were exchanged, I felt indescribable emotions.

A story I remember. A story I don't remember. Even stories I didn’t intend to tell. The story I hadn't written for the past three years was still continuing here.

I suddenly had such a question.

Can I say that I love this story more than them?

"What is the name of the sword that Jung Heewon received as a gift from Kim Dokja in the Theater Dungeon?"

"Me! Me!"

Judge Heewon, who was sitting next to me, also managed to get one question right.

Ji Eunyu muttered in a nervous voice as she watched him excitedly pull back the curtains and disappear.

“If this continues, we’ll be the only ones left. Is there a penalty for staying behind?”

Ji Eunyu also began to raise her hand from then on.

After about ten or twenty questions, Ji Eunyu got an answer right.

"I'll go first. See you outside."

Even after Ji Eunyu waved her hand and disappeared, I didn't raise my hand.

The struggling readers also stood up from their seats one by one after answering a question correctly.

There were also readers who suddenly wiped away tears.

I watched them leave the theater for a long time.

"Now there's the last question left."

A voice that echoes through the silent theater.

Before I knew it, I was the only one left in the audience.

Looking at the countless empty seats in the front row, I thought about the person named “Kim Dokja” for the first time in a long time.

"This is the final question."

I was nervous and listened to the question.

There should be an easy question.

The host asked with a bright smile.

"Who is the heroine of ORV?"

I opened my mouth for a moment then closed it again.

Maybe sensing my embarrassment, the host added to reassure me,

"I'll give you a minute to think."

ORV's heroine.

Who would Kim Dokja think of as a heroine? I don't know. Because I'm not Kim Dokja.

So, I decided to think about it from the perspective of ORV's writer, "Writer Lee."

「Who is the heroine of ORV?」

In fact, since "ORV" was not a story written with a heroine in mind, the proportion of romance was almost non-existent.

"10 seconds left."

"The heroine of ORV—"

I said the name of the heroine I was thinking of. I wasn't sure if he was talking about this person. Compared to other main characters, she didn't appear that much.

Nevertheless, that person was a person I made for Kim Dokja.

The host was silent for a moment at my answer then asked,

"Why do you think so?"

I'm probably not the one who loves this story the most.

I may not be the one who knows this story best.

But I wanted to say this at least once.

"Because I wrote it."

"What?"

The host asked back as if he hadn't heard it properly.

I smiled bitterly and raised my voice.

"Because she's my favorite person."

I couldn't tell if my answer was the right answer or not.

However, the host nodded without saying a word, and slowly clapped his hands.

Is that right or wrong?

When I think about it, the host has never once said “correct answer” so far.

"Congratulations."

With the host's words, I walked down the stairs of the theater and went to the stage.

As I followed the path that the readers had walked down before me, the empty seats of the theater came into view.

The words [Fourth Wall] were faintly glowing on the screen.

Suddenly, I remembered the readers who walked down this road, wiping their eyes, and the readers who were smiling and looking back every now and then.

Only then did I seem to know their feelings. They didn't cry or laugh because they were happy to get a question right.

Because this is the completion of 『Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint』.

I felt like I was going down the road that I should have gone down a long time ago.

The readers reached the end point in their own way, and now it was my turn.

When I went up the stage, the host was waiting for me. We looked at each other for a moment on stage.

The host looked at the nickname written on my name tag.

[■■■]

"Your nickname is very hard to pronounce."

I smiled and nodded.

Even though I saw it up close, I couldn't see the host's face well. The voice was strangely neutral, so I couldn't tell if it was a man or a woman.

I suddenly wanted to ask if he was “RepresentativeKimDokja.” But I didn't ask. I thought I wasn’t qualified to ask.

"The goods are beyond the curtain. You can just pick it up and leave."

I was a little excited when I heard that it was a product.

What is it? A cultural gift certificate?

I reached out to the curtain of the stage. Then I stopped. Because if I open this curtain, I really thought this story would end.

Isn't there still a story left to write?

There are sentences that I forgot and words that I haven't written.

At the last moment, I looked back. I thought there were still people left.

And if someone was there, I thought I wanted to write a story for that person.

But there was really someone in the place I looked back.

When did he move there?

The host was waving in the middle of the audience.

You can see the audience better than I thought on the stage.

I waved back at the host, then slowly turned back and pulled back the curtain.

Now, it was time to live in the world after the end.

"Are you really going to end it like this?"

But at that time.

“If you finish it on your own, what will the rest of us do?”

I heard the host's words.

Yes? The moment I was about to answer, I heard a tsutsutsutsu sound from somewhere. I reflexively held my cell phone. It wasn't the phone vibrating.

"So, please tell me that story."

Something was swirling in front of my eyes.

Ugh.

The vortex sucked me in, including the sound in my mouth. Sparks flew in front of me and my vision flickered. It felt like someone had rolled my body into a ball and thrown me into a subway that kept repeating infinite sudden stops.

My mouth tasted a bit like vomit after holding my breath.

And when I opened my eyes.

「I was really on the subway.」

A slightly higher field of view than usual.

A lukewarm wind blew from the vent hanging from the ceiling. Smelling the strangely musty smell of underground dust, I blinked.

The vague sensation of floating slowly clung to my skin, and a sense of reality gradually returned.

「To be exact, it was a subway station.」

Why am I here? As soon as I asked the question, an answer emerged from deep within my mind.

I already know where this place is.

「“But author-nim, why did you start on the subway?”」

One day, Ji Eunyu asked me that.

「“Because it's the most natural place.”」

But I couldn't accept that answer.

"What the hell is this?"

I was surprised at how unnatural the voice that came out of my mouth was.

I looked forward reflexively.

On the screen door, a man with narrow eyes was looking at me, not “Lee Hakhyun.”

"No—"

An unknown cell phone was in my hand.

I absentmindedly pressed the phone’s power button.

「It was just a coincidence that I looked at the time at that moment.」

The clock numbers on the phone changed with a ticking sound.

7:00 PM.

The moment I raised my head, I heard a message from somewhere along with a small explosion.

[The free service of planetary system 8612 has been terminated.]

[The main scenario has started.]

I knew the sentence that would follow very well.

「It was the moment the genre of my life changed.」

That was not what I thought.

「So.」

At that moment, I was “thinking.”

「I entered 『Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint』.」

Author’s Note

The serialization cycle of Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint is 7 PM on Monday, Wednesday, Friday and Sunday. If there is a change, we will notify you in advance.

Once again, thank you very much for joining us in Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint.

Now, updates on Munpia are only on Monday, Wednesday and Friday at 12 AM UTC+0.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 556 Episode 2. Rewrite (1)

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"Do you know what a living thing is, author-nim?"

—Comment from chapter 6 of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

---

I once shared such a joke with Ji Eunyu. I asked her if we would survive if we were to fall into the first scenario of Omniscient Reader.

Ji Eunyu answered me like this.

—Honestly, I'm not confident, but what about you, author-nim?

What did I say? I don't remember.

What I do know is that the joke was now real.

「Oh my God.」

This was such an extraordinary situation that I couldn't help but use the punctuation.

I touched my face in the reflection of the screen door several times. It wasn't because I was handsome. It wasn't that there was something weird on the screen door.

My face had literally changed.

"What the....."

Crooked smiling eyes, thin lips with a subtle hint of meanness.

I realized where I'd seen this face before.

Sure enough, there was a life-size figure standing at the entrance to the theater with the same face.

But I couldn't remember who he was.

Was he an undescribed extra?

[The free service of planetary system 8612 has ended.]

[The main scenario has started.]

Throughout the subway station, citizens voiced their confusion.

"What is this?"

"I'm not the only one seeing this, right?"

"There's something here. Hey, can you feel it? There's something like a wall here."

A certain radius of the station was surrounded by a transparent wall. It was a wall I knew well.

The scenario device that makes it impossible to get out until certain conditions are met.

"No, where are the subway employees? Aren't they making announcements?"

"Someone will come. Let's wait."

Now there was no doubt.

「I had possessed someone from 'Omniscient Reader'.」

A slow shiver ran up my spine.

「An extra character I don't know.」

It was a common trope in web novels, but I couldn't think of any reason why I should be possessing someone.

Why me? Did I earn someone's grudge? Did one of the characters put me in here?

The Han Sooyoung from the event theater was real?

Then was it Han Sooyoung?

It could be. Han Sooyoung, who didn't want me to pretend to be Omniscient Reader's author, had put me here.

It could also be Yoo Joonghyuk. The way I described all the misery he went through was enough to make him hold a grudge against me.

Maybe it was Kim Dokja, who wanted to take revenge on me for revealing the protagonist's secret tastes to the entire universe. Or maybe he did it for no reason at all, he just has a bad personality.

Shit, I don't know. There's no point in thinking about it now.

I pushed the uncertainty out of my head, leaving only the certainty.

One, I was in an 'Omniscient Reader'.

Two, I'm possessing someone else.

Three, the scenarios were about to begin.

I quickly scanned my surroundings. If the first scenario is about to begin, I need to figure out what I can use to my advantage.

First, I'm in a subway station.

The station is from the orange line, so it's line 3, and the station name is.....

「Geumho.」

I slowly frowned.

In my head, I recalled some information about Geumho Station. It was the first base of the main character, Kim Dokja, and the place where the massacre took place.

Of course, that was in the second half of the first volume, and fortunately, I hadn't gotten to that point yet..... In a sense, it could have been more dangerous now.

[Ah, aah. ^&@@#%.]

I felt like I was being dragged down into the cold depths by my ankles.

I never thought the day would come when I'd be able to see a Dokkaebi with my own eyes. Two little horns. A creature with fluffy fur wearing a small straw mat.

I remember. He had this kind of role at first.

[Can you hear me?]

Kim Dokja's streaming contract partner, the Dokkaebi Bihyung.

[Uh-oh, at least it's quieter here than on other places, huh.....]

Bihyung looked back at the moment and our eyes met. I lowered my head in surprise. It's only in the second half of the story that Bihyung becomes sympathetic to Kim Dokja, while the earlier Bihyung is a crazy monster who breaks the heads of incarnations for fun.

Fortunately, I didn't see any humans getting their heads cracked off while arguing with Bihyung like in the main story.

Especially that big guy over there.

[Okay, I'm going to explain what's going on, so listen up.]

I knew full well what Bihyung was going to say next. I've written dozens of manuscripts where I've seen that line.

He's probably running a similar script simultaneously in the scenario area he controls.

[You have been living too long for free. Isn't life too generous? You were born and paid no price for breathing,eating, shitting, and reproducing at will without paying anything in return! Ha! What a world you've been living in!]

As I listened to him, I wondered if this is what it would have been like if a 'Omniscient Reader's movie had come out.

The problem is that I'm now an extra in that movie.

[The stars watched over your planet with great generosity, but that's only until today, and the time has come for you to repay them for all the kindness they've shown you. It's better for you to see what's going on than to hear me ramble on about it, right?]

As if he couldn't be bothered to recite the boring lines, Bihyung snapped his fingers.

[#BI-7623 channel opened.]

[Constellations have entered.]

A small window floated upwards above those who raised their heads in confusion.

[The main scenario has arrived!]

**<Main Scenario #1 - Proof of Value>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: F

Clear Conditions: Kill one or more creatures.

Time Limit: 30 minutes

Reward: 300 coins

Failure: Death

The Dokkaebi's transparent body slowly faded away, giving us a vague smile.

[Then, good luck everyone. Please show me an interesting story.]

As the scenario window popped up in front of me, it really hit home.

The time limit reducing in real time.

Right now it says 30 minutes, but as the time goes on, the penalties will start to kick in.

"What does this mean?"

Unsure of what's going on, people started talking to each other and calling out to each other. In the distance, I could see people scratching and hitting the transparent wall.

I took a light, deep breath and muttered to myself.

'Attribute Window.'

[Currently, due to a system error, the Attribute Window cannot be activated.]

I squinted my eyes.

This wasn't working?

'Fourth Wall.'

I called it out, just in case.

Kim Dokja had the [Fourth Wall] skill since the beginning, and as a penalty of that skill, he was restricted from viewing the Attribute Window.

So, if I also have the [Fourth Wall.].....

'Fourth Wall.'

.....

I don't.

So why doesn't it open?

I don't know.

It's a novel I wrote, dammit.

First of all, I'm a writer, not a reader, so I should have the [Writer]'s skills... Maybe I have [Avatar].

I concentrated and tried to use [Avatar] and other writer-only skills. But there was no noticeable change, except for the strain on my sphincter.

[The remaining time has decreased.]

[There are 28 minutes remaining.]

While I struggled in vain, the crowd in the station split into two groups.

One was a group of people wearing sweatshirts with the same logo.

"Everyone, please don't panic and gather this way!"

"Let's go to the deacon's side!"

They were clutching tissues with the church's name on them; they seemed to be from the same church.

On the other side of the room, a large man with a tattoo on his forearm was gathering people.

"Hey, everybody, come over here and help!"

This was the same guy who was worried about getting his head cracked by Bihyung earlier. The big guy pushed against the transparent wall with both hands and shouted at the other people.

"Everyone push this together! We might be able to get out!"

Obviously, it's safer to struggle against a wall than to attack a Dokkaebi.

But some people didn't think so.

"What if we do something weird and that monster does something to us?"

"Then what? If you're not going to help, go away. Push! Harder! Harder!"

At this point, some of the other people who had been hesitating joined in and started pushing

against the wall. The sound of cha, cha, cha, cha echoed around the room, and the people in the church who had been watching got involved.

"Everyone, let's help him!"

At the deacon's signal, the congregation rushed in and pushed against the wall. It was quite a sight to see, dozens of people clinging to the transparent wall like a pantomime.

I slowly made my way to the edge of the station as people struggled with the wall. A few steps away, I caught my reflection in the screen door.

First, I think I'm possessing a bad character.

A body whose average stats does not seem to exceed 1.

This is why I wasn't sure I could win a fight against a bare-chested Kim Dokja.

Kim Dokja.

I have to meet him somehow.

I don't know what caused me to possess this man, but considering what's normal in web novels, I should be able to return to reality the moment I see the end of the scenarios.

So I needed to meet the main character of 'Omniscient Reader', who dies and comes back to life for the sake of his colleagues, and win his favor. It's the only way to increase your chances of survival in this cruel world.

By the way, I'll have to survive here before you can meet Kim Dokja or anyone else.

「The first scenario requires you to kill 'one or more living things'.」

Kim Dokja cleared the first scenario by crushing the grasshoppers and grasshopper eggs collected by Lee Gilyoung.

But since he's the main character, he's lucky, and since I'm an extra character, I'm not so lucky.

As an extra character, I can't be that lucky.

「So this is what I came up with.」

I glared at the soda machine in front of me.

If you didn't end up in the same train car as Kim Dokja, you'd be lucky to land in a subway station.

At least here, this vending machine was my 'insect catcher'.

"Push! Harder!"

"Aaaahhh."

I gently shook the vending machine in time with the chants of the wall pushers.

「A lot of bugs live in subway vending machines with refrigeration and freezers.」

I had seen an article like that when I wrote about 200 chapters for Omniscient Reader.

I wonder how many times I shook it like that.

Something made a thud sound, and a nameless bug crawled out from under the vending machine.

I quickly clasped my hands together and trapped the fleeing bug.

Lucky for me, I'll survive the first scenario.

I immediately tried to crush the bug in my hand.

「Maybe it's a pregnant bug.」

My hesitation wasn't because I was philosophizing about the bug's right to life.

I hesitated because I remembered a line from 'Omniscient Reader'.

「An 'egg' is a living thing.」

In the scenario, bugs' eggs are recognized as living beings, and Kim Dokja's solution was to crack hundreds of eggs to gain an advantage in the scenario.

But what would have happened if Kim Dokja had given the bug's eggs to everyone on the subway?

I glanced over and saw people banging on the transparent wall.

People knocking on the wall to live.

I knew who the people in Geumho Station were. People who could casually take the lives of others for their own survival.

For a moment, I felt like Kim Dokja.

「What would Kim Dokja do if he returned to the first scenario?」

Suddenly, a tsuchuchut rang out and I almost missed the bug.

It wasn't a probability spark.

The cell phone in my pocket was ringing.

I hesitated for a moment, then slipped the bug in my fist into my coat pocket and zipped it up tight.

I opened my phone and a message popped up.

[You have one new message.]

A message?

—Sender: RepresentativeKimDokja

—Author-nim. Congratulations on your new side story series.

I looked at the message with suspicion in my eyes.

—We're sending you a small gift in anticipation for your series.

---

Author's Note

Sing: I am not Lee Hakhyun. ^^;;

Shong: I'm not Lee Hakhyun either. ^^;

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 557 Episode 2. Rewrite (2)

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In 'Omniscient Reader', there is a scene where Kim Dokja is trapped in the subway and tls123 sends him a text file of 'Ways of Survival'.

Apparently, 'RepresentativeKimDokja' was parodying it now.

Normally, I would have laughed out loud, but this was no time for that.

Because I was in a situation where I could really die.

Were they the one who got me into 'Omniscient Reader'?

I don't know. But the circumstances seem to point to a connection.

I'm going to reply first.

[You can't reply to this message.]

I knew it would be like this if it was 'Omniscient Reader'.

I decided to check the gift from Kim Dokja.

Let's see. Kim Dokja received a text file of 'Ways of Survival', so I assume I got something similar.

But no matter how much I scrolled down, I couldn't see any attachments.

—We're sending you a small gift in anticipation for your series.

That was the end of the message. There were no attachments, and I didn't feel like I had a new exclusive skill.

So what was it?

I realized that the message was sent through a web novel platform.

It happened to be the app I used to use.

Wait, we have this app here too?

Most of the menus didn't work because the app wasn't from this world line.

However, I was able to check my novel, which worked fine.

> Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint - 551 chapters
>
> -Author Lee Hakhyun

A list of episodes of 'Omniscient Reader' popping up with the familiar platform screen.

> .....
>
> Episode 1. Starting the Paid Service (4) +[117]
>
> Episode 1. Starting the Paid Service (3) +[164]
>
> Episode 1. Starting the Paid Service (2) +[158]
>
> Episode 1. Starting the Paid Service (1) +[332]
>
> Prologue. Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World +[681]
>
> .....

Apparently, this was 'RepresentativeKimDokja's gift.

Just as Kim Dokja received the text file of 'Ways of Survival' from tls123, I had received 'Omniscient Reader' from 'RepresentativeKimDokja'.

It was a little disappointing, but it was better than nothing. Even if you're the writer, you're bound to forget the setting of a story three years after its completion.

I suddenly became curious about the Kim Dokja of the first scenario.

What exactly was he doing at this point?

It must be around chapter 4 or 5 by now.

I immediately pressed chapter 5.

—How is the main character so calm? Wasn't he a real loser?

But what popped up in front of me was not the text of the novel, but a comment.

I clicked on the text again.

—The scenario is too difficult...

Another comment.

At first I thought it was a bug.

But as I clicked again and again, only getting comments, I realized what "gift" I'd been given.

No way.

Some of the comments I vaguely remembered, others I didn't remember at all.

No wonder. It was already three years ago.

Wow, I'm about to die in the first scenario.

My mindless scrolling suddenly felt really heavy.

I hesitated for a moment, then pushed the scroll up.

—Hmm... I don't think I can do that.

—He can only do that because he's the main character. If he was a normal person, he would be dead already.

I felt the dark, still air wet the tip of my nose.

I was suddenly back in Chungmuro's theater.

I read the stories of the readers filling the screen.

Readers of those days were still in elementary school, they were in middle and high school, they were in college, they were working..... They were preparing to enlist in the army and get a job.

The history they had lived was still there.

—I don't think I'm capable of killing people... I think I'll just keep quiet and wait for the end.

I thought about 'Judge Heewon', who solved the quiz with shining eyes, and the young reader who asked about Kim Dokja's life and death.

The reader who fluently explained the secret of the number 1,863, the reader who remembered the total number of ■..... The readers who sat there with faces I didn't recognize.

"It isn't moving at all! What do we do!"

"Shut up and push more!"

The readers who had come to the theater, all of whom had taken the quiz and disappeared into the lights behind the curtain.

"Somebody, somebody do something!"

If.

"Please let me out, I need to get out of here!"

What if it wasn't just me, but also other readers came here.

"Help me! Help me!"

[There are 27 minutes remaining.]

I know this is not the time to think about this. My nose is asleep right now. I have to stay alive, and I have to find Kim Dokja somehow.

Kim Dokja.

"Hey."

Somehow.

"Maybe."

I have to meet.....

"Bugs....."

I looked toward where the voice came from, dumbfounded.

Where I turned, there stood a middle-aged man who seemed to be in his forties. Deep brown eyes with dedicated eyebrows.

I definitely didn't recognize him.

What did this man just say?

I tried to calm my pounding heart and put on an exaggeratedly brash voice.

"Excuse me? What do you mean?"

He looked at me for a moment, then asked.

"I was wondering if you could teach me how to catch bugs too."

I looked at him for a moment.

His face unreadable.

I could feel people looking this way in the distance.

If I drew the wrong kind of attention here, I could ruin the whole scenario.

After a moment of thought, I blinked slowly, then turned my head and pointed to the bottom of the vending machine with a jerk of my chin.

"Ah."

As if that was enough, he let out a small exclamation.

I said warningly.

"Don't draw too much attention to yourself, I don't know how many are left."

He nodded thoughtfully, then bent down and began whisking the underside of the vending machine.

I pretended to be oblivious to the spectacle, shifting stealthily to shield him from the others.

I wondered if it would be right to save him here.

This choice could have resulted in a branch of the book completely separated from the main story. But.....

"I found it, thank you."

It wasn't long before he found a bug, too.

It was a tiny bug, so tiny you couldn't even tell if it was pregnant or not.

"Kill it right away."

He nodded, and promptly crushed the bug. Then.

"Ah."

A faint glow formed in his hand as he killed the bug, and then it was gone.

The man's slightly loosened eyes stared off into space.

Presumably, the scenario had been cleared.

Fortunately, 'killing bugs' still seemed to work.

"Yeah, really. This is....."

I stared at him in disbelief and then asked him by surprise.

"1,863."

"What?"

"1,863."

I wanted to be sure.

If this guy had really read 'Omniscient Reader', he had to know what it meant.

The middle-aged man paused for a moment, then opened his mouth.

I was a little disappointed when I saw the look in his eyes that said he really didn't know.

Maybe it was just my imagination.

But the middle-aged man continued.

"If it's 1,863, do you mean..... from 'that novel'....."

I reflexively looked at him. He was looking at me, too.

I could see a faint mix of relief and despair in his eyes.

"Am I right?"

As expected, this man was a reader of 'Omniscient Reader'. I'm not sure if he was in the event theater with me, but he had been suddenly transported here, just like me.

His lips trembled and he muttered.

"How in the world did this happen....."

"It's not the time to go into details. Please keep your voice down."

"Ah, yes. I wonder if there are others."

"If there are others, I'm sure they'll do something to stand out."

From what I could tell, he wasn't a very perceptive man.

Nevertheless, in this situation, he realized that this was the first scenario of 'Omniscient Reader', and he didn't miss the scene where I captured the bug.

I'm sure other readers will feel the same way.

At the very least, they will be observing me and this ahjussi or trying to find bugs themselves.

[There are 25 minutes remaining.]

We observed people for a while. However, no one was doing anything particularly remarkable.

Ahjussi asked.

"About the rest..... What are you going to do?"

"The rest?"

"Those people."

Actually, I already knew who he was referring to.

The ones clutching their phones in terror and the ones still struggling to push through the transparent wall.

"No matter how you look at it, this is real, isn't it?"

"....."

"At this rate, they're all going to die."

I get what he's saying. If he was a reader of 'Omniscient Reader', I could understand saying that.

But I wasn't a reader.

"We can't save them all."

I said, as quietly as possible so that this conversation wouldn't be overheard by the constellations and the others.

"If we want to safely clear the scenario, we can't change the plot too much, I'm sure you know that."

"The bug you caught earlier....."

He asked as I paused.

"Why haven't you killed it yet?"

To say this guy is clueless is an understatement.

I said in the most stern voice I could muster.

"Even Kim Dokja wouldn't have saved them, and you know what kind of people they are."

"Kim Dokja....."

The ahjussi's eyes turned dreamy for a moment, and he opened his mouth as if to sift through a nostalgic memory, then said with a bitter smile.

"My daughter really loved that character."

What in the world had brought this man here?

Suddenly, the old question came back to me.

「If Kim Dokja were to return to the first scenario, what would he do?」

"Hey, there!"

Someone was running like a wild boar in this direction.

It was the big guy who had been pushing the transparent wall earlier.

"What are you guys doing? Can't you see how hard everyone else is working?"

Before I could respond, the big guy grabbed me by the shoulders and shoved me roughly toward the vending machine. His strength was incredible, like he had a strength level of at least 7.

I exhaled sharply as I was instantly lifted off the ground.

This must be how Kim Dokja felt.

Startled, the ahjussi grabbed the big guy by the arm.

"Wait, you can't do that."

The big guy frowned and looked back at him. It was like he was looking at a bug.

The big guy let go of my grip and slapped him across the face. He let out a faint groan and rolled on the floor.

"Didn't you hear me? Can't you see the other people over there trying? Did you think I wouldn't notice if you were hiding out here like rats?"

I steadied my breathing and stepped toward the big guy.

It was the first time I had ever seen such real violence in front of me. Blood splattered on the floor, and the ahjussi reached for me as if asking for help.

Of course someone would stop him.

It's common sense.

There's no place in the world for that kind of violence.

"You should have helped when we asked for help. Tsk."

"They're hiding to make themselves comfortable?"

"They deserve it."

When I turned my head, they averted their gaze as if they had never said anything.

「I stupidly forgot. This world is fiction.」

I thought, clutching the bug in my pocket with all my might.

I wondered if killing the bug for a few coins would be enough to save him.

No matter how I looked at it, the big guy's physique was far superior to mine or the ahjussi's.

That's when I remembered the system messages.

[You can use the possessed person's exclusive attributes.]

[You can use the possessed person's exclusive skills.]

I was possessing a body.

And this character... was a character I didn't recognize.

'I'll use it.'

I don't know.

Anything is better than "Lee Hakhyun".

[The possessed's exclusive attribute has been activated.]

[The possessed's exclusive skill has been activated.]

With the system message, my mind suddenly calmed down. The things I needed to say and the things I could do were sorted out.

「Don't be scared. It's actually kind of fun.」

I took a breath and swung my fist as hard as I could at the vending machine.

Bang!

The surprised people took a few steps back.

Bang, and bang.

I don't know how many times I hit the vending machine like that.

A new bug emerged from under the vending machine. Not a grasshopper, not a cockroach, but a small, nameless bug.

I looked down at it for a moment.

"What is it, do you want to die?"

I looked up and the big guy who had been beating the ahjussi glared at me.

The crowd that had slowly gathered was looking in my direction.

I opened my mouth to speak.

"Everyone."

[The effect of the exclusive attribute is effective.]

This could have been an easy scenario.

But the constellations know, the readers know, and I know that easy scenarios aren't fun.

"I have something to say to all of you."

I could have been drawing attention to myself unnecessarily and made myself a target. I might do something stupid and ruin everything.

But I had to do this now.

I didn't particularly want to be a hero. This was just the last bit of pride I had left, so to speak.

「"Author-nim."」

Ji Eunyu's voice rang in my ears.

The ahjussi looked up at me, bleeding.

As I helped him to his feet, I thought to myself.

Maybe this person is one of the theater's readers. Or maybe one of the readers in the theater was his daughter.

I imagined the audience in my head. But the darkness in the theater was so deep, I couldn't make out their faces.

「"Have you written anything?"」

So I decided to imagine the Kim Dokja I knew.

A man with a thin face and a cheeky grin.

A friend who loved stories more than anyone else in the world. He was willing to be the protagonist of my story, and in the end, he really became the story itself.

I sold his stories, made money, and ate.

I survived.

"Now, if you believe me and follow my words."

I must give back to Kim Dokja what I have received.

"I will save you all."

With a story Kim Dokja doesn't know yet.

.

.

.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is interested in your story.]

---

Author's note

Don't tell me it's Kim Dokja?!

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

# 558 Episode 2. Rewrite (3)

---

"What the hell are you talking about?"

The first one to react to my declaration was the big guy.

I've written a lot of characters like him throughout my entire writing career, so I know what to do when this happens.

I tried to paraphrase Kim Dokja.

"You've been fighting against an impenetrable wall, and now you're done. As you've probably realized by now, that's not going to get you out of this."

"What? How do you know that?"

"Don't turn a blind eye to reality."

Meeting my gaze, the big guy shivered.

"Unless you really want to die."

A chill ran through the station as if someone had poured it with cold water.

[The station's incarnations are startled by your words.]

[Your exclusive attribute's effect is strongly activated.]

[Your influence in the scenario area becomes slightly stronger.]

So this is my character's attribute.

Surprisingly, he's not a bad character.

"You might want to listen to this guy, he knows something about the situation."

As the ahjussi added his well-timed comment, people turned to look at me and shook.

I didn't miss the moment when the mood changed.

"Now, as you all know, this is real. It's not a movie shoot, it's not a dream. Neither the police nor the army will come running to save you, and if you mess up, you could really die. However, if you listen to me, you'll all be safe."

At last, a few people hesitantly gathered around.

About ten people.

It wasn't a bad start.

A young man in the front row asked.

"What are you, ahjussi, a soldier or a cop?"

"I used to be."

My words added to the uproar.

It wasn't a lie, as I had retired as a sergeant in the army.

It was then that the deacon, who had been listening from afar, approached.

"Do you really know something about this situation?"

"Yes, I do."

"How?"

"There's no point in going into detail, because frankly, no matter how I explain it, it's not an easy situation. If I suddenly told you that God was angry at your sins and sent you a

trial, would you believe me?"

I gave a lighthearted example, but the deacon's eyes narrowed and he mumbled.

"Sins..... trials.....?"

I must have touched the wrong switch.

The big guy who was listening to the conversation beside me got angry.

"Are you kidding me?"

Normally, his gruff demeanor would have intimidated me.

But today's Lee Hakhyun was different.

"Anyway, if you want to listen to me, listen to me, and if you don't, go over there and keep pushing against the wall. Honestly, I don't care if only this ahjussi and I survive."

This kind of brazenness would have impressed even Kim Dokja.

Perhaps the persuasion worked, a few people looked at each other and shared their opinions.

The most active was the deacon.

"Brothers and sisters, let's hear what he has to say."

"Let's do it. We're all going to live with it, aren't we?"

As the mood shifted slightly in my direction, the big guy bit his lip and glanced at me.

By the way, when we were being beaten up, we 'deserved it', but now we were all going to live together?

I took a breath and began to speak.

"Something happened that we can't understand with our common sense. We were suddenly trapped inside by an invisible wall, and we were given this thing called a 'scenario'. First of all, we need to start by acknowledging this as a reality. Do we agree on that?"

People nodded hesitantly.

I continued.

"If we don't clear this scenario, we will die."

"Do we really have to kill? No matter what—"

"You have to believe that for now, as surreal as it seems. It's better than making a bad decision and dying. Have you checked the conditions for clearing the scenario?"

"Kill one or more creatures....."

Watching the people in front of me timidly close the distance between us, I took a step forward, trying to be defiant.

"Gather a group of humans and ask them to kill a creature, which of course sounds like asking them to kill each other, but there's a trap in that statement."

"What trap?"

I smirked, watching the big guy who said the same thing over and over again.

"You could have just told them to kill 'humans'."

Their eyes widened in disbelief.

"Then the solution is....."

"It's simple. We just need to find another creature we can kill."

With that, I slammed the vending machine with all my might. Then I pointed to a cockroach that scurried out from underneath.

"Ah!"

People gasped as they realized.

I nodded.

"If we all work together, we should be able to collect bugs quickly."

"Let's do it, right now!"

"Let's all put down the vending machine!"

People now clung to the vending machine instead of the invisible wall.

Their faces became livelier, perhaps because this time they had a sense of reality.

"Push!"

The moment the vending machine was pushed, a can of soda fell out with the sound of shaking.

No one took the drink.

"One more time!"

The vending machine tilted, and soon I heard something break.

The next thing I know, bugs are falling out of the back of the machine.

"They're out! Let's catch them!"

I shouted to the rushing people.

"If you catch a bug, don't kill it, show it to me first!"

"What? Why?"

I continued to speak firmly, despite their wary glances.

"I need to see if it's carrying eggs."

"Eggs?"

"An egg might qualify as a life form, so if we find one, we can all live."

"Ah.....!"

"Remember, you have other people's lives in your hands. Only we can save each other."

People glanced back at each other, then took off their shoes and socks and start catching bugs.

Some people hit the vending machines with their bags or fists, while others grabbed nearby fire extinguishers and hit it with them.

Even the big guy who had been giving me a hard time joined in and kicked a vending machine.

The reader ahjussi —the one who's daughter likes Kim Dokja— slowly came to my side and asked.

"Are you okay?"

"What about you?"

"I'm fine."

We watched the bustling crowd.

Wiping blood from the corner of his mouth, the reader ahjussi said.

"You decided to save them all."

People scrambling to kill the bugs.

This would change the story of Geumho Station.

Those who were supposed to kill people and survive would kill bugs and survive.

Maybe even that big guy who wasn't in the original story.

"Is it because of me?"

The reader ahjussi lowered his head as if feeling guilty.

This will change the course of the entire novel, and we will face a future we don't know.

I put my hand lightly on reader ahjussi's shoulder.

"Don't think about it. I was going to do this from the start."

The number of people who caught one, two, and more insects began to increase.

Among them was the deacon, who had already secured his share of bugs.

"It's all thanks to you, brother. Thank you."

"No, it's not."

Perhaps this deacon was meant to die.

I felt a strange pang of guilt at the thought.

How many people have died like this in my novel?

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' begins to trust you.]

It was then that I suddenly heard the character's inner thoughts.

My heart started to beat fast.

I felt that something was finally coming.

As expected, I had an exclusive skill.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' has been activated.]

[Character List.]

A skill that allows you to view the information of the characters in 'Omniscient Reader'.

It was a skill that Kim Dokja, the main character of Omniscient Reader, also had.

I tried to use the skill on the deacon.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated.]

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Kim Cheolyang

Age: 27 years old

Sponsor: None (No constellations are currently showing interest in this person).

Exclusive Attributes: Crouching Figure (General), Attention Seeker (General)

Exclusive Skills: [Irrational Blind Faith Lv.2], [Cognitive Dissonance Lv.3]

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.1], [Strength Lv.2], [Agility Lv.2], [Magic Power Lv.3]

> Overall Evaluation: Kim Cheolyang feels that his faith is currently being tested; he wants to be a leader who is recognized by the people, but he has been unable to overcome his natural personality and he's crouching down.

Character Kim Cheolyang.

I thought the name sounded familiar, and then I remembered that I had written down a character named Kim Cheolyang at some point.

However, it was in one of over 10,000 notes, and I couldn't recall any details since the character was included in an abandoned setting.

By the way, for an extra character, his exclusive attribute is pretty interesting.

'Crouching Figure.'

It was originally Jung Heewon who had the Crouching Figure attribute in the original version of the story.

Depending on the circumstances, this trait has the potential to put him on the list of the 100 strongest in the world.

Is he a great unknown character?

Kim Cheolyang, who didn't know what I was thinking, kept talking.

"It's a good thing that this happened during the outdoor evangelism..... and I'm so glad we met you."

"Oh, yes."

"Maybe the end of days has finally come, and like brother said, God is watching us."

He's probably watching us pretty hard. Grabbing a handful of popcorn for every head that explodes.

"I think we're doing pretty well with your help, though."

"Shhh."

"Huh?"

Suddenly, I understood why I abandoned this character.

How dare he say 'pretty well'.

That line is a trigger in 'Omniscient Reader'.

—Hoo.

Shit. As expected.

—Here's another one who's playing tricks.

The message was atypical.

A message that used the one-on-one dokkaebi communication instead of the official channels.

It was an ominous omen.

There was no such development in the main story of 'Omniscient Reader'.

—Don't make it obvious, just listen. I'm telling you this specifically because it's funny.

When I quickly lowered my gaze and pretended nothing happened, Bihyung continued talking with satisfaction.

—I see what you're thinking, but you'd better use your judgment. The constellations don't like incarnations that are too smart.

Apparently, Bihyung was talking because of his own personal benefit.

Maybe they didn't like what I was doing.

I laughed bitterly as I looked in the air where Bihyung might be.

What would you, a low level dokkaebi, know? I'm sure I know far better than you what the constellations like.

—Sometimes it's wise not to think too hard.

That was all Bihyung said.

"Found it! I found another one!"

"We're not quite there yet, we've got a lot of people left—"

"The trash can! Let's look in the trash can, too!"

The number of people trapped together was exactly twenty-two.

We needed to secure at least twenty-two bugs for everyone to survive.

"Found one!"

"Here, take another one!"

There were also people who had already caught bugs and were holding them for others. It was a very moving scene.

It was hard to believe that these were the same people who fought for food in the original 'Omniscient Reader'.

The big guy picked up a large cockroach from afar and waved at me with a big smile on his face.

"Hey, is this one okay? It's a living thing too, right?"

I nodded.

[There are 21 minutes remaining.]

The bustling crowd slowed down noticeably.

I turned to them and asked.

"Is there anyone who hasn't caught a bug yet?"

No one raised their hand.

Twenty-two bugs, to be exact. That was the same number of people trapped here. It was a clean sweep, the best possible result, without having to search for bug eggs.

"Hey, can we kill it now?"

"If we kill it, can we get out of here?"

Relief washed over their faces.

The pleasure that we had survived together without harming anyone.

After carefully checking everyone's hands for a bug, I nodded.

"Brothers and sisters, let's thank our insect brothers for their sacrifice!"

With the deacon's declaration, several people clapped their hands and slapped down the bugs they held.

When the tension eased a bit, some people asked silly questions.

"Can I step on it?"

"You don't have to kill it with your hands, do you? You just have to kill it."

When I told them they could kill them any way they wanted, they started stomping on the bugs like dirty children.

Squish!

Similar sounds echoed around the room.

Even the big guy, who had torn off all the bugs' legs afraid that it would escape, crushed it with his feet.

"Die! Die!"

I opened the pocket that held the bug. The dead bug was there, along with some thick body fluids. I must have squeezed it too tightly earlier when I tried to save the ahjussi.

I could hear the crowd cheering.

"Is it okay now?"

I was a little worried about the change of the development at Geumho Station, but as I looked at the reader ahjussi's faintly smiling face, I realized that it was okay.

Maybe now the people of Geumho Station will be able to live a completely different life from the one I wrote.

"Nothing happened, are you sure it's over?"

Someone asked anxiously.

"Has anything changed?"

People looked at each other and asked.

"This thing is dead, right? Is it because it's a bug?"

The big guy who had been trampling the bug in the corner questioned.

I don't know how many times he trampled on it because the giant bug was crushed by the sole of his sneakers and I couldn't find any trace of it.

I thought back to the first scenario of 'Omniscient Reader' and suddenly realized an eerie fact.

I turned to the reader ahjussi.

"Ahjussi."

"What?"

"Did you get the system message after you killed the bug earlier?"

"Yeah. The scenario is cleared....."

I pulled out the dead bug from my pocket.

A bug that I couldn't tell when it died.

A chill ran down my spine.

「I didn't receive any system messages.」

---

Author's Note

Turn it off and on again.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 559 Episode 2. Rewrite (4)

---

I stared down at the bug's body for a long time.

It didn't make sense. Something must be wrong with the <Star Stream> system if it still deemed this bug to be 'alive'.

"Now I just have to wait, right? I did as I was told."

"Hey, we've completed our assignment, let us out!"

Why isn't there a scenario completion message. A system message should have appeared as soon as the bug was killed.

[There has been a problem with the main scenario system.]

With a tsuchuchut sound, Bihyung appeared out of thin air. He looked back at me and the others with a troubled look on his face.

[Hey..... everyone.]

The moment I saw his face, I realized what I missed.

I was an idiot. Why didn't I notice sooner?

—Here's another one who's playing tricks.

A little while ago, Bihyung said that in the dokkaebi communication.

That meant that I wasn't the only one who was playing the scenario in an unusual way.

At first, I thought he was referring to Kim Dokja.

But there was something I hadn't considered.

There wasn't just one 'reader' in this scenario.

Bihyung, who was twitching his lips, spoke up in a disapproving voice.

[It seems like you all think this is some sort of insect killing game. The scenario this time is really strange. Can the same thing happen at the same time?]

I looked at the ahjussi. He seemed to be thinking the same thing.

"No way....."

Somewhere in the world, there are readers who have read 'Omniscient Reader' just like him.

They knew the solution to the first scenario, just like we did, so they chose to catch bugs and clear the scenario.

What we didn't realize was that too many people had used that solution.

[The Bureau has detected an unnatural flow in the scenario.]

[The probability of the scenario begins to tilt.]

[The will of the <Star Stream> is moving.]

A trope that has been tried so often, it has lost its novelty.

[You've got to hand it to humans for being cruel, killing poor bugs to save their own lives....]

I glanced down at the bug carcasses strewn throughout the station. Miserably squashed and trampled corpses.

The recognition of bugs as 'living things' might mean that they were also 'scenario participants'.

So what did we look like in their eyes?

Bihyung looked at the bug carcasses on the floor, shook his head, and turned away.

"W-what's that all about?"

"I thought we were supposed to kill bugs to live?"

"It'll be fine, I'm sure he's just trying to scare us."

"Right, right, we played by the rules!"

In this world, the rules of the 'scenario' were absolute.

In particular, the 'Main Scenario' had an authority that even the dokkaebis could not violate.

No matter how much Bihyung disliked the situation, the main scenario could not be changed unless the entire Bureau moved.

Tsuchuchuchut.

It had to be like that.

"U-uaaa! What's going on?"

This had never happened in 'Omniscient Reader'.

Not even when the <Kim Dokja's Company> entered the 1,865th round with Group Regression.

I instinctively looked up into the air.

I couldn't see any stars in the ceiling-blocked sky. However, somewhere in that unseen sky, there must be constellations watching our underground struggle.

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is moving.]

I remembered the grand principle of the <Star Stream> that I had forgotten for the past three years.

「The probability of the <Star Stream> moves towards the direction stars are interested in.」

[The main scenario contents have changed.]

It felt like the celestial body of the universe was tilting.

And at that exact tilt, I could hear the laws of the world twisting.

[For this scenario only, 'bugs' are excluded from 'living creatures'.]

[For the purposes of this scenario, 'bug killing' is no longer recognized as 'killing a living thing'.]

People screamed everywhere.

In the center of the abyss, I saw my own reflection in a window.

Through a door's window, a strange man was smiling at me.

「Now that's more like 'Omniscient Reader'.」

---

I once wrote that a story becomes a different story when you read it again. I still think that's right.

I didn't mean it like this.

**<Main Scenario #1 - Proof of Value>**

Clear Conditions: Kill one or more creatures.

Time Limit: 30 minutes

Reward: 300 coins

Failure: Death

* In this scenario, 'bugs' are not treated as 'living things'.

* Clearance conditions for this scenario will no longer change.

When I read it again, the scenario actually changed.

The 'killing bugs' that Kim Dokja used is no longer allowed in this scenario.

"H-how can you do this all of a sudden!"

"Did anyone get a different message?"

Judging by the looks on their faces, no one had cleared the scenario.

I glanced in the reader ahjussi's direction, and he lowered his voice.

"It says I cleared it."

Luckily, the reader ahjussi was the first to kill the bug, and the scenario was recognized as cleared.

"Don't make a fuss, and pretend you didn't clear either."

"Okay, but you....."

I shook my head, and his face turned pale.

He must be blaming himself for my death.

"Oh, my. Then—"

"Don't worry about me. It's not really me you should be worried about."

"What?"

"The rules have changed, and the person who was supposed to live may die."

The person who was supposed to live.

That is, those who had survived by 'killing bugs' in Omniscient Reader.

"No way."

Reader ahjussi seemed to have thought of that as well.

「Kim Dokja might die.」

We didn't yet know if the changed rules were specific to some regions or if they would apply to the entire scenario area.

But now we had to assume the worst. If, in the unlikely event that this change kills Kim Dokja, then—

「Someone will have to replace Kim Dokja.」

Reader ahjussi asked, his lips trembling.

"What do we do now?"

"We'll have to think about it, I don't know yet."

The terrified people raised their voices to the air.

"We killed a creature, what the hell?"

[A few constellations are giggling.]

For the first time, we heard a message from the constellations.

The stunned people looked around in horror.

Deacon Kim Cheolyang, who came rushing over, grabbed me by my shoulders.

"Brother, what are we going to do? Is there any other way but the bugs?"

Not only Kim Cheolyang, but all the other people who were looking for bugs rushed toward me.

"You got us into this mess! What are we going to do now?"

"Take responsibility!"

They shouted at me. As if I was responsible for this whole mess.

I calmly retorted.

"Because of me?"

"Uh, well, you're responsible anyway! You're the reason we're all going to die!"

"Calm down. No one's going to die. Just because the bugs failed doesn't mean there is no way out."

"You're right. I can kill you if I have to."

The big guy who had stopped trampling on the bug was coming toward me, dragging the soles of his sneakers.

I looked at him and said.

"Of course, that's one option, if you're willing to deal with the aftermath."

"What?"

"After that's over, people will remember the killer."

If he was Kim Namwoon, this logic wouldn't work.

But the big guy wasn't as crazy as Kim Namwoon, and he stopped approaching me.

In the future, only murderers will survive. However, that's not something that ordinary people can easily conclude.

It was the lack of imagination that I dug into.

"Then what? We have to kill living things to live."

"We can kill something. Not bugs nor people."

"What if the conditions change again? We just failed."

"They won't change this time."

"How do you know that?"

"Have you even read the scenario?"

I could see people opening the scenario window in a panic.

"It's true, the conditions won't change now."

"Can we believe this?"

I hadn't intended to go this far, but now the tables had turned.

"There's going to be a prime minister's speech on the news soon, and level one national disaster is going to be declared."

"What?"

"Here's what he's going to say."

I said like a newscaster, recalling the opening lines of 'Omniscient Reader' I'd revised dozens of times.

"To all my fellow citizens, unidentified terrorists are currently active in an unspecified number of areas, including Seoul."

At my words, people opened their phones and started browsing the internet.

I quickly added before they could find the video.

"For your information, the president is already dead, and the prime minister will be killed during his speech."

Less than a dozen seconds later, someone screamed.

"The prime minister is really speaking!"

The prime minister's voice came from cell phones everywhere.

—To all my fellow citizens, unidentified terrorists are currently active in an unspecified number of areas, including Seoul.

Those were the exact words I spoke. The next sentence was no different.

The current government will fight against the terrorists with all means and methods, and there will be no negotiations. Therefore, the people should go about their daily lives with peace of mind.....

As the Prime Minister continued to speak, people looked in my direction as if possessed.

Then.

"U-uaaak!"

A startled citizen dropped his cell phone.

The prime minister was dead.

His head exploded in real time.

"What the hell is this.....!"

As events unfolded as I said, the big guy stuttered.

"You must have secretly looked it up online."

"W-what are you talking about, it was live!"

"How the hell do you know that, brother?"

I didn't answer back.

A few gunshots rang out, and Bihyung's face appeared on the screen, replacing the prime minister.

I could hear gulps of breath all around me.

[Everyone, I've told you already. This isn't a game like 'terrorism'.]

I'm sure other readers are seeing the same thing I'm seeing right now.

But from now on, they were about to see something a little different.

Normally, at this point, the remaining time would be reduced by 10 minutes, and if the first kill didn't occur within 5 minutes, a penalty is triggered that wipes out all life in the area.

This will not be the case this time around.

「Because the scenario's clear conditions can no longer be changed.」

After the Bureau intervened once to remove the 'bugs' from the scenario, the first scenario's clearance conditions were completely locked.

Therefore, the 'time penalty' will not be triggered this time.

[There are 20 minutes remaining.]

With a beep, a timer appeared out of thin air, and Bihyung laughed.

[There are twenty minutes left now. If you don't want to die, keep your chin up. Especially if you don't want to end up like your leaders.]

With those words, the screen flashed with images of the National Assembly members' heads exploding.

The frightened people stood back in horror.

"What the hell is this—"

"U-uwaaa!"

A sense of dread settled over the entire station. Strangely enough, the horror actually uplifted me deeply.

Suddenly, I wanted to write like crazy.

「We gained 10 minutes, so 'killing bugs' wasn't all for nothing.」

If I survive this, I might write the side story.

[The 'exclusive skill' becomes more active.]

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Author's Note

There's 3 consecutive chapters today.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 560 Episode 2. Rewrite (5)

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The people who watched the prime minister die in real time lost their minds and ran toward the transparent wall they had pushed against earlier.

"We have to get out of here now! Break this wall!"

"Push it again, it might get pushed back!"

[Until the scenario in the area is completed, any kind of entry or exit is restricted.]

Panicked people clung to the transparent wall. They reminded me of a swarm of insects in a mosquito net.

I took a short, deep breath and shouted in a loud voice.

"Everyone, pull yourself together. There's still plenty of time."

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is looking at you with a strange look in his eyes.]

[A few constellations are surprised by your calmness.]

"It was the lawmakers who died, not us."

The people look up at you with dazed faces.

[Some incarnations begin to rely on you.]

[Your influence in the scenario area has exceeded a threshold.]

Now that their reason was paralyzed by fear, I had an opportunity.

"We can still choose how to survive."

Our way to survive.

One by one, the people cowering nearby stood up, looking at me.

"B-but. But they're all dead! The president, the prime minister—"

"They were just ordinary people too, who happened to wear those titles."

I heard someone hiccup.

"Get a grip. If you lose your mind here, you'll be left with only one option."

"....."

"And that's going to kill most of us here. Of course, some of us will survive, but they'll be few."

I glanced toward the big guy as I said that, and he growled and glared at me.

But that was his mistake. One by one, the people nearby swarmed toward me, wary of the man.

"What the hell, you guys."

They realized. How the weak survive in a predatory ecosystem where laws and rules are broken.

I continued speaking.

"No one has to die. The strong, the weak, everyone can survive, and there's no need to be disappointed that the bugs failed, it was just the 'first way'."

One by one, people's faces changed. Among them, the one whose expression changed dramatically was the deacon's, Kim Cheolyang, who had made the mistake of saying

'pretty well' earlier.

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' is convinced by your words.]

[Character 'Kim Cheolyang' feels a strong sense of trust in you.]

"Is there another way? Besides bugs or people..... What else could we kill....."

While people were confused, I thought and thought and thought.

If we couldn't use 'bugs' anymore, now I had to find a new answer.

The first thing I did was to open my phone and check the comments on the 'first episode' of Omniscient Reader.

—If a bug works out, what about bacterias? Bacterias are living things.

This is a story I didn't write.

—Doesn't stomach acid kill bacteria even if you don't move? Doesn't that mean you can survive without doing anything?

—Ah, that's ridiculous.

A world line that exists only as a possibility, imagined by the collective intelligence of readers.

—What's the principle of hand sanitizer? Doesn't it kill germs?

—Wouldn't using a hand sanitizer on your palm save your life?

—There's a lot of germs everywhere.

.....

—What happens if you kill yourself?

"I'm going to tell you the 'second way.'"

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk37: But does that really work? |

[There are 16 minutes remaining.]

"Here's a lighter."

"Clothes are made of fabric, so they'll burn fast, right?"

"It doesn't matter what it is, they're germs, they'll stick to it."

To execute the 'second way', people quickly obtained the supplies I asked for.

"Are you sure this will work?"

I nodded gently and began stacking the bundles of old clothes people had collected in the center of the station.

Our plan was simple. If the bugs didn't work, we'd kill something else. Something too small to see that existed everywhere.

Deacon Kim Cheolyang asked with concern.

"But do germs count? Aren't germs invisible?"

"God is also invisible, isn't he?"

Kim Cheolyang seemed to get a little angry at my words.

Wondering if I had gone too far with the joke, I quickly added.

"In biology class, we learn that bacteria are also living things. Even if you can't see it, it's still a living thing."

I could tell he wasn't convinced, so I explained a little more.

"Think of it like aliens. There must be life on planets in the far universe, but we can't see them."

"Brother, there are no aliens. Only pseudo-religions believe in that."

"Anyway, I'm just giving you an example."

"I see, so you're saying they're living things even if we can't see them."

I nodded, but even I wasn't 100 percent convinced by this strategy.

Does killing an invisible creature work to clear the scenario?

In fact, there is no clear answer to that even if you read the whole novel.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is interested in your strategy.]

[A few constellations wonder what you're trying to do.]

However, there is a commonly accepted 'answer' in all scenarios.

「The one that will be interesting and convincing to the constellations.」

I mutter to myself, staring at the ceiling.

"Maybe it doesn't matter so much what you kill, but how it makes the person who observes it feel."

"What?"

"Maybe what we're killing is one of these germs."

I opened my phone and showed him a list of the germs we were likely to kill and what they looked like.

Germs that are always present in subway stations, but we've never actually seen.

Organisms you can't see with the naked eye, so you wouldn't normally care.

Now people had to kill them to survive.

"I looked it up, and germs are actually living things."

"This time we'll succeed, right?"

Still, people's faces lit up a bit at the thought of a new breakthrough.

Not everyone, of course.

"You've all lost your minds."

The big guy grumbled, glaring at me and the others as if he didn't like the situation.

But then he glanced away, and he opened his phone and began to surreptitiously search for something.

I peeked my head out to see what he was searching for.

—bacteria life

—insect life

—life

—athlete's foot

—propecia side effects

As he was excitedly perusing the list of search terms, reader ahjussi next to me whispered.

"Will this work? We won't be able to identify the germs we kill."

"Well, we'll do what we can. Just because you can't find the bodies of the people you kill with

missiles doesn't mean you didn't kill them."

If we had an electron microscope, it would be possible to confirm the death of the bacteria directly, but we didn't.

So for now, we had to do whatever we could.

If we can't see the bacteria, we have to at least do something that makes it clear that we intend to kill them.

That way, the constellations would understand what we were trying to do.

"Will burning really kill the germs? What if they don't die?"

"They're going to die. Why do you boil water? Because it sterilizes everything."

"Is that so?"

"Brothers, didn't you look it up earlier? You should know exactly how to kill them."

"Oh, deacon. We're old and don't know what you mean."

Kim Cheolyang explained to them in frustration.

"Ah, germs die because their proteins are denatured when they're heated, right?"

I glanced at Kim Cheolyang with a questioning glance, and he nodded wordlessly.

A moment later, a small campfire blazed in the center of Geumho Station.

> —rlaehrwk99: But by that logic, shouldn't you live because the bacteria in your stomach will die even if you stay still?
>
> —rlaehrwk24: The stomach is an involuntary muscle, so it's hard to say there was an intention to kill.
>
> —rlaehrwk99: Isn't it possible to kill by controlling the stomach with force?
>
> —rlaehrwk24: The involuntary muscle is....
>
> —rlaehrwk37: Yoo Joonghyuk would be able to control his stomach with force.

People threw the bodies of dead bugs and other miscellaneous items they had into the fire.

Kim Cheolyang threw his cell phone case into the fire, and reader ahjussi tore receipts from his wallet.

Others threw their shoes into the fire or pulled out their hair.

The big guy, who was wary of people, secretly took off his socks and threw them into the fire.

"My sock....."

No one brought up the last words of the big guy.

10, 20.....

The people stood still and watched the bonfire burn.

Sitting around the campfire with such a serious look in their eyes, it felt like we were at a religious retreat.

They were praying to an invisible god, thinking about invisible germs.

I did the same.

The invisible bacteria burned in the sacred flame.

They were burning.

I believed they were burning.

However, imagining the death of unknown germs was as difficult as imagining the faces of nameless readers.

What happened to them?

Like the reader ahjussi with his hands clasped together, muttering something, others must be alive somewhere in this world.

Judge Heewon who sat next to me in the theater, the girl who wondered if Kim Dokja was alive or dead, the reader who knew the secret of 1,863, and the reader who memorized the number of ■.....

I closed my eyes and imagined them safely completing the first scenario.

"Did anyone get a message or anything?"

I said, and they looked at each other. Eyes nervous, like worshippers waiting for a message from God.

"Oh, there's something in front of me....."

At that moment, God's message appeared in front of everyone.

[Due to excessive modifications to the current scenario, there is an error with system message display and payment compensation.]

[Scenario clear messages will be automatically delivered after the time limit has elapsed.]

Someone muttered in surprise.

"What the hell is this....."

No need to ask, the message was simple.

No matter what we do next, we won't know if the scenario is cleared until 'the end of the scenario'.

I was stunned.

No way, I didn't expect this from the administration.

It was at that moment that a tsuchuchut went off in my head.

[What the hell are you thinking?]

With a tired face, Bihyung appeared.

[This season has been really weird. What is wrong with all of you? If you couldn't kill insects, now it's bacteria... Because of you all, there's an error in the scenario system. Since the message display isn't working, I can't look at the results in advance!]

Judging by what Bihyung said, the situation was not intended by the Bureau.

Meanwhile, people were also getting annoyed.

"What's up with that? We can't know if we've passed this or not."

"Hey, did we solve our scenario?"

"Bacterias are living things, right? Please answer me!"

Bihyung frowned at the people.

[That's.....]

The moment Bihyung opened his mouth, sparks flew in the air once again.

[The constellations of the 'absolute evil' system warn the dokkaebi 'Bihyung'.]

[The constellations of the 'absolute good' system warn the dokkaebi 'Bihyung'.]

[The constellations watching the scenario do not want the dokkaebi to intervene in the scenario.]

Something doesn't feel right about this.

[Hmm..... If the constellations say so.]

Bihyung looked around at the incarnations with a frosty gaze.

[Finding the solution is also part of the scenario, so I cannot tell you the answer. But as a special service, I'll let you know what happens if you fail the scenario.]

The moment I heard that, I checked the timer.

[There are 10 minutes remaining.]

It was time for 'that' to show up.

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Author's Note

Thank you. There is one more.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 561 Episode 2. Rewrite (6)

A giant holographic screen appeared in the center of the subway station.

People screamed in surprise.

The screen showed a classroom.

Shaking girls in navy blue school uniforms.

It was a scene I recognized.

「Daepong Girls' High School.」

The girls on the screen were working together to break down the classroom door.

Of course, their efforts will fail, because this is such a story.

An ominous beep, beep, beep, beep—

The girls screamed.

[The given time has run out.]

[Paid settlement will begin.]

With the announcement, the girls' heads began to explode one by one.

I opened my eyes and stared at the scene. I had a responsibility to see the story through to the end.

On the screen, the last remaining girl clutched her friend's throat.

A choked groan.

Then the only survivor on the screen looked around.

[#Bay23515 channel. Daepong Girls' High School, Year 2 Class B Survivor: Lee Jihye.]

The exact same development as 'Omniscient Reader'.

Lee Jihye, who was glaring at the screen, disappeared and Bihyung laughed.

[How about it. It's funny, right?]

"H-how—"

The people in the room froze in horror.

Even the big guy was quite surprised, and the eyes of the reader ahjussi, who probably already knew the story, were shaking.

I was the only one who didn't panic.

[The character 'Lee Hyunjoo' is freaking out!]

[The character 'Yeom Baekhoon' is freaking out!]

Psychological messages from characters were coming from all over the place.

Bihyung touched the exact spot where people's anxiety was coming from and disappeared again.

"T-the kid who survived at the end. She must have killed someone."

Someone muttered as if possessed.

The chorus of voices around him spread like wildfire.

"Are we wrong? What if the germs aren't the answer?"

"Are you sure you know what you're talking about? Are you sure we can survive?"

I had to appease them somehow.

"Wait a minute. Can you all calm down?"

"How are we supposed to calm down now?"

The terrified people shouted at me.

The reader ahjussi, who had been watching the situation from the sidelines, stepped forward to dissuade them.

"We don't know the outcome yet, do we? This guy wants to save you all too, so come on __"

"The problem is that we don't know the outcome! If we're wrong, we're screwed!"

"You're the same! You two are friends, aren't you?"

"We're all going to die now because of you, what are we going to do!"

In an instant, the people surrounding us were ready to lynch us. There was also the big guy in the middle of the crowd, smiling with satisfaction.

When I first set up this plan, I knew this would be a crisis point.

I also had a plan for this moment.

[There are 9 minutes remaining.]

But then I got tired.

I wondered if it would be wiser to just run away with the ahjussi and kill the nine minutes.

With these cowardly thoughts running through my mind, I searched the subway for a suitable

hiding place.

As soon as I did that.

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' is looking at you.]

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' wants to do something unexpected.]

A message rang in my head.

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '■■' have been met.]

[The exclusive skill '■■' has been activated.]

.....■■?

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang's attribute is preparing to bloom.]

[You can interfere with character 'Kim Cheolyang's attribute blooming.]

[The exclusive skill '■■' is activated!]

The scenery around me turned colorless, and people's actions slowed down drastically.

I, too, stiffened and stopped moving.

In a world where time had stopped, only the letters floated in the colorless background.

「Lee Hyekyung thought, 'It's all because of him.'」

「Kim Haemoon thought, 'I'm being punished by heaven for killing a bug.'」

「Ji Hyungdong didn't like those narrow eyes from the beginning.」

When I looked closely, there was another sentence floating above my head.

「And Lee Hakhyun realized what the skill was.」

Then a message appeared in the white space in front of me.

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

[Describe the next action of 'Kim Cheolyang'.]

# Kim Cheolyang's Awakening

Cheolyang■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■

* At your current skill level, you can write a total of 150 additional characters.

Spaces that emerged like unfinished manuscripts.

It wasn't hard to understand what those blanks were.

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield (雪源)' for a total of 3 minutes.]

Just as Kim Dokja had a 'reader' skill, I had a 'writer' skill.

Skill '■■'.

Will what I write come true?

Since I didn't have much time, I decided to write a sentence in the blank first. The purpose was clear.

Use Kim Cheolyang to save me and the ahjussi from the crisis.

As I concentrated, the sentences flowed out of my head.

It was natural.

I'm Omniscient Reader's author.

「At that moment, an unknown loyalty sprang up inside of Kim Cheolyang for the man with the narrow eyes[1] This loyalty soon awakened him.」

[NOTE 1]

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' evolves into 'Judge of Destruction'.]

"Stop. Don't touch him." (149 characters in total)」

That's it.

At a glance, it was a perfect development.

Using the fact that his attribute is 'Crouching Figure', I evolved Kim Cheolyang into a 'Judge of Destruction' like Jung Heewon.

As far as I'm concerned, it's an excellent double-entendre.

[This story is ridiculous.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 1%.]

[You're running out of probability.]

Huh?

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

I nodded in agreement.

> rlaehrwk37: I'm getting off

I stood dumbfounded for a moment, then regained my composure. Now was not the time to be shocked.

I resumed writing my sentence.

「At that moment, Kim Cheolyang realized that he was actually a martial arts master in his previous life..... (147 characters in total)」

[This story is impossible.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 0.1%.]

[You're running out of probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

> rlaehrwk37: I'm getting off

「At that moment, Kim Cheolyang realized that he was Kim Namwoon's cousin. The unknown affection towards his own blood that flowed from him..... (143 characters in total)」

[This story is bizarre.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 3%.]

[You're running out of probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk37: Do you want to die? |

I wrote a couple more times like that with no luck.

After taking one comment punch after another, I was mentally exhausted.

[There are 30 seconds remaining.]

I started to feel self-deprecating. I couldn't think of anything to write or how to write it.

I closed my eyes, watching the time tick away in real time.

It's times like these that I need to go back to the drawing board.

「"Author-nim."」

Then I heard the voice of the dokkaebi Ji Eunyu in my head.

「"What does this character want?"」

Ah.

[There are 20 seconds remaining.]

[The exclusive attribute is in effect!]

I thought about Kim Cheolyang, a character who existed only as a setting.

[There are 15 seconds remaining.]

How he would act in this situation, what he would say, what he would want to be.

Just like the day I first wrote 'Omniscient Reader', I frantically wrote sentences.

I spoke as Kim Cheolyang and acted as Kim Cheolyang.

At that moment, I was Kim Cheolyang.

The moment I typed the last word.

[The time limit has expired.]

[This story is plausible.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 90%.]

[There's enough probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk37: Oh |

I don't know what that "oh" means, but at least it surprised the reader.

By the way, this asshole, I'll remember your ID.

[Successfully recreating the scene.]

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

I felt the power draining from my body, and the colors around me returned to normal.

The excited people came toward me and reader ahjussi and I could see the big guy come to us.

Then.

"Everyone."

「At that moment, Kim Cheolyang stepped forward.」

The sentence I had written began to come to life.

"Our faith is being tested right now."

「Not anyone could do it. But the moment he stepped forward, he was seized with an intense belief that he had been chosen by God.」

"Faith?"

「Maybe it was the fire. I could see the fire burning beyond their pupils.」

That's all I wrote. However, it was enough for an introduction.

According to [Character List], Kim Cheolyang sees this scenario as a test of faith.

"I'm sure you've all noticed by now that someone is watching us from the sky."

[The eyes of a few constellations light up.]

The crowd roared at the timely message.

Encouraged, Kim Cheolyang became more determined and shouted.

"The 'gods' are watching our choices, whether we choose justice or evil."

[Evolution of character 'Kim Cheolyang' is imminent!]

[The words of the character 'Kim Cheolyang' move people's hearts.]

"Think about it with common sense. The one who killed a human and cleared the scenario, and the one who cleared the scenario without killing anyone. Which one is more just, and who would the gods be rooting for?"

The listeners shook their heads. Some muttered, 'That's right' and 'murder is a big sin'.

Kim Cheolyang continued.

"The answer is set. We chose the right side, and the only thing left is our faith in ourselves. We even met a 'God's emissary' who knows the future."

God's emissary?

Kim Cheolyang, who suddenly stood up from his seat, pointed at me over the campfire.

"We listened to him and found a way to solve the challenge without anyone dying. We've already passed the ordeal."

That's a line I didn't mean him to say?

The moment Kim Cheolyang looked at me with passionate eyes, people also looked back at me.

And then.

"Maybe the deacon is right. There's no way we'll be asked to kill human beings."

People started talking.

"Look at those kids in the video. They're all dead because they were trying to kill each other."

"People's lives are so precious!"

A life-threatening situation in an unrealistic scenario.

There's a god watching over them, and a religious person affirming and encouraging their choices.

Killing was scary, faith was close.

Survival, in which they all believed, was sweet.

Hope, which was powerless when they were separated, became a religion when a single event brought them together.

"Kim Cheolyang! Kim Cheolyang!"

"We were chosen, we were chosen....."

Someone cried out in excitement.

I could see reader ahjussi sighing lightly from the side.

Anyway, thanks to the great work of the awakened Kim Cheolyang, the crisis for me and the ahjussi seemed to have passed safely.

But that wasn't the end of the story.

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' has awakened the new attribute 'Cult Leader'.]

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' has acquired a new religious view.]

[The character "Kim Cheolyang" has acquired the basic doctrine of the 'Life's Teachings'.]

Life's Teachings (生命教).

The moment I heard the name, a chill ran down my spine.

One of the ten thousand notes in my head came back to me clearly.

「At that moment, Lee Hakhyun remembered exactly who 'Kim Cheolyang' was.」

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' had accepted your 'view of life'.]

[You had a great influence on the establishment of the religious view.]

I realized what I had done.

The character Kim Cheolyang.

My first notes about him are as follows.

「From the Ten Evils (十惡), the Life Leader Kim Cheolyang.」

The Ten Evils, the worst villains of Omniscient Reader.

I just raised one of them with my own hands.

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Author's Note

Thank you.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: meaning Lee Hakhyun, but Kim Cheolyang didn't know his name yet.

# 562 Episode 2. Rewrite (7)

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While writing Omniscient Reader, there were a few times when the plot would break down.

A character would suddenly speak in a historical drama style, or they would forget a skill (or more accurately, I would forget it).

I apologized to my readers and made changes to save the day.

But what I did this time was impossible to fix.

"Let's praise the germs who made a significant sacrifice for us."

As if having a profound impact on the cult's religious views wasn't enough, I'm now also involved in the re-emergence of the Ten Evils.

"Oh— germs, germs, bacteria."

What the hell have you done, Lee Hakhyun?

The reader ahjussi next to me was clapping his hands with the wrong beat, unaware of what was going on.

[Your influence in this scenario area is significant.]

[The 'view of life' you spread dominates the religious views in the area.]

I wondered if I should just lean into it and become a villain.

It was not a wise idea.

"Oh— the great sacrifice of the germs."

If I ran into Yoo Joonghyuk while doing something like this, I would be decapitated with a single blow.

[The character 'Lee Hyunjoo' believes in you.]

[The character 'Im Baekhoon' believes in you.]

[The character 'Yeom Youngcheol' believes in you.]

Still, I didn't feel too bad that everyone believed in me.

I've never had so many people believe in me in my life.

[Most of the incarnations in the area are moved by your words.]

After one hymn, the tension eased, and people sat around the campfire in a circle.

A few people sipped canned drinks from the vending machine, talked, and prayed.

"Isn't this supposed to kill germs? Lactobacillus acidophilus is also a bacterium. I hear no one makes it to the intestines alive."

"Where were you going, ahjumma?"

"I was just on my way to pick up my son's yogurt. What about you?"

"I had dinner plans with my girlfriend."

"Well, that's funny, because I was just on my way to go to see the chicken restaurant I opened with my wife, and then this tragedy....."

Others handed me a canned drink and said.

"Bacteria are also living things, this is the first time I've realized it. Wow, young people are so smart."

"You should study well. Where did you go to college?"

I didn't answer, just smiled meaninglessly.

With a speech by Life Leader Kim Cheolyang, both religious and non-religious people had a strange look on their faces.

They say that religion is a drug to overcome death, and maybe that's true.

However, not everyone was high on it.

"Are you all crazy? There's a surefire way to live, but you're going to let it go?"

Not surprisingly, it was the big guy. He had something like a pipe in his hand; I didn't know where he got it from.

I couldn't see him for a moment, then I realized he'd been searching through the station for it.

"If you want to get fucked, get fucked alone."

The people's faces tensed as the weaponized big guy approached.

"Wait a minute, what's wrong with you? You burned your socks earlier."

"Naive assholes. You really believe it's killing if you kill something you can't even see or tell if it's dead or not?"

"Well, so what?"

"Have you forgotten what that monster showed us earlier? The surest way to get out of here alive."

The big pipe pointed at the people.

"Kill someone here, and you'll be sure to live."

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is chuckling.]

I think I know what's going on.

Apparently, one of the constellations encouraged him.

I looked at the big guy and activated [Character List.]

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Lee Cheoldoo

Age: 39 years old

Sponsor: None (one constellation is currently showing interest in this person).

Exclusive Attributes: Gangster (general), Ex-convict (general)

Exclusive Skills: [Dogfight Lv.3], [Bluff Lv.3], [Intimidation Lv.3], [Headbutting Lv.2]

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.7], [Strength Lv.7], [Agility Lv.6], [Magic Power Lv.1]

Overall Rating: This is the boss of the 'Cheoldoo Group'. Characterized by a hard head, he has a powerful headbutting technique.

The boss of the 'Cheoldoo Group', Lee Cheoldoo.

It wasn't until I read the description that I realized who this guy was.

Come to think of it, there was a group called 'Cheoldoo' at Geumho Station.

The Cheoldoo Group's boss wasn't in the original story of 'Omniscient Reader', but I had created a setting for it.

I took a step forward and said.

"Don't panic. We're in a group, and he's alone."

No matter how many weapons Lee Cheoldoo had, or whether he was the Cheoldoo Group's boss, he couldn't fight against twenty-one people.

But Lee Cheoldoo didn't let up.

"Whoa, wait a minute. Kill you all? I only have to kill one of you. From these 27..."

As he scanned the faces of the people, one by one, as if he was picking out the weakest bug, he glanced in my direction.

"Let's be honest with each other, you're all scared to death of believing that bastard too, aren't you?"

Lee Cheoldoo laughed lightly and slapped his pipe with his palm as if he understood.

"First ten people. Stick to my side, and I'll take responsibility and save you no matter what."

He took another step forward, adding.

"The rest of you, be prepared to die."

Everyone took a step back as Lee Cheoldoo approached.

Kim Cheolyang panicked and shouted.

"Don't listen to him, everyone. We've already won the right to survive! There's no need to fight unnecessarily!"

Then, the enraged people shouted in unison.

"That's right, you killed the germs too! You can live if you stay still, why are you doing this?"

"Maybe you don't get it yet, but it's okay now? You can live because you killed the germs."

Still, killing bugs and germs together created a sense of camaraderie, and the unity of the people wasn't bad.

[The incarnations in the area are united.]

[The influence of the religious view is growing stronger.]

Lee Cheoldoo scratched his ears in disbelief and became irritated.

"You're really crazy. Then let's just have one of you die to me."

"D-don't panic, if we all fight together—"

"I don't care how many of you there are."

Lee Cheoldoo's pipe hissed and scraped the floor.

"You'll die in the order you come."

The people backed away in horror.

If everyone pitched in, they might be able to subdue him.

However, no one was willing to step forward.

As he searched for a target, Lee Cheoldoo's eyes landed on the man closest to him.

Realizing that he had been targeted, he called out to the surrounding area.

"H-help me, please! Help me!"

But no one tried to help him. The crowd quickly backed away like a swarm of bugs that had been discovered.

Lee Cheoldoo raised his pipe as if he knew that would happen.

[The character 'Kim Haemoon' is panicking!]

"S-save me! I'll stick with you!"

Character Kim Haemoon. He had been passive ever since he killed the bug.

Lee Cheoldoo said fiercely.

"No, I don't need you anymore."

"Please, please! I'll give you 100 million if we get out of here, I can even send you the money right now!"

Lee Cheoldoo frowned as he thought for a moment.

"100 million. Then you decide who to kill."

Kim Haemoon looked at the others with trembling eyes.

The first person he looked at was the ahjumma who said she was going to give her son yogurt.

She was the first to run away when Lee Cheoldoo turned toward Kim Haemoon.

[The character 'Lee Hyekyung' is terrified.]

"W-why are you looking at me! I have to live, my child is waiting for me!"

Kim Haemoon's head turned to look at the man next to her. It was the young man who had dinner plans with his girlfriend.

[The character 'Jeong Hancheol' is looking around.]

Jeong Hancheol quickly looked back and forth between Kim Haemoon and Lee Cheoldoo, and gave a small, friendly smile.

"Can I be on your side?"

Kim Haemoon's head snapped back to the middle-aged man beside him.

[The character 'Ji Hyungdong' is freaking out.]

This time, it was the man who said he opened a chicken restaurant with his wife.

I walked over to him, thinking it was a bad idea. The time limit was about to expire, so I had to drag it out somehow.

But when he saw me, Ji Hyungdong pointed at me.

"I-If you're going to kill someone, kill him! He made this whole thing happen!"

At first, I thought I had misheard him, but then people started chattering around me.

"That's right. He got us into this mess, so he should be held accountable."

They were obviously friendly people until a while ago.

"W-why are you looking at us like that? He's not wrong."

"What's wrong with you, young man? Fight. Fight and win."

"At times like these, you step up like a man!"

My breathing became stifled, as if I were the bug trapped in my pocket.

Lee Cheoldoo smiled at me.

"Okay, you'll work."

In an instant, the surroundings became silent.

When I turned around, people began to avoid my eyes as if they had made a promise.

Even without [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], it was obvious what they were thinking.

「As long as it's not me.」

I wasn't surprised.

I already knew this was their nature.

I looked at the approaching Lee Cheoldoo and thought to myself.

Average physique, strength and agility of 7.

I wonder if I can beat him.

[There are 5 minutes remaining.]

Let's just hold on for five minutes.

I looked at Kim Cheolyang for the last time. He looked at my pupils and made a complicated expression.

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' is very troubled.]

[The character 'Kim Cheolyang' is a person whose 'sentence' you wrote yourself.]

[You have a very good understanding of the character.]

I didn't have [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], but Kim Cheolyang's internal thoughts echoed in my ears.

「There are three people who have influence in this station right now.」

「Me, the narrow eyes man, and the big guy.」

Kim Cheolyang's eyes quickly switched between me and the big guy.

「If I don't stop him, he'll die.」

「I don't think he's going to listen to me.」

「If I don't succeed, I'll.....」

Quickly changing his posture, Kim Cheolyang took a step away from me with the people and shouted loudly.

"Don't move rashly, everyone. Stand back. God's emissary is about to offer atonement for us."

Kim Cheolyang is a man who fears his power being threatened. If he can't stop the beast anyway, he'd rather take advantage of the situation.

A way to strengthen his position and justify my death.

"No matter how insignificant, a life is a life. Right now, God's emissary is going to sacrifice himself to atone for killing the bacterial brothers. Let's all say thank you."

It was ridiculous, but the people's eyes were already filled with madness.

They, too, had agreed to sacrifice me for their own survival.

Jeong Hancheol and Ji Hyungdong whispered as they retreated.

"Germs are living beings, you could have just looked it up on the Internet. It's not like it's a big deal. You'd have figured it out eventually, right?"

"Let's not get into this, let's stay neutral. There's a reason he's so upset."

I was still calm.

「No writer is ever surprised by their own words.」

Lee Cheoldoo's shadow was cast on the spot where the others had retreated. The feet that had been relentlessly trampling on the bug turned toward me.

"If it's decided, the rest of you get lost. I'm only going to kill this asshole, as promised. Hey, get out of my way."

People at a short distance were beaten on the arms and legs with the pipe.

"Aaaak! My arm!"

"Don't be stupid, come over here quickly! Only one person needs to die!"

The terrified people quickly ran to the scenario barrier.

Just like that, everyone was far away from my side.

[There are 3 minutes remaining.]

Only one person, the one person who hadn't run away, was still with me for this ending.

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Author's Note

There are two chapters today.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 563 Episode 2. Rewrite (8)

---

The reader ahjussi standing next to me shook his stiff shoulders and whispered in a low voice.

"Don't fight, just run away on the count of three."

I couldn't know, but he probably read the whole Omniscient Reader.

I'm sure of it.

No, I forgive him if he didn't.

"You should run away, ahjussi. You don't look like you have high stats."

"No, I'll drag it out with you. We don't have much time left, just hang in there—"

Screaming like a wild boar, Lee Cheoldoo lunged at me, aiming for the back of my head.

I threw myself as hard as I could and crashed into him.

"Ouch."

Lee Cheoldoo dropped the pipe, slightly shocked. However, due to the weight difference, he didn't fall.

In the next moment, I saw Lee Cheoldoo's golden teeth shining white.

"You're like a hero."

Lee Cheoldoo lightly pinned down my arms and then headbutted me in the face.

Luckily, I remembered seeing the Headbutting skill in the [Character List], so I reflected my head back, but I was still shocked. My vision spun and my knees sank.

When I came to my senses, Lee Cheoldoo was already mounted on top of me.

I opened my mouth to speak, pretending to be as calm as possible.

"Lee Cheoldoo, leader of the Cheoldoo Group."

His eyes widened at my words.

"What, do you know me?"

"Are you planning to be a murderer for the rest of your life?"

"You asshole....."

Lee Cheoldoo laughed unpleasantly and whispered in my ear.

"Wouldn't that be better than dying?"

[There are 2 minutes remaining.]

Instead of replying, I turned my head and scanned my surroundings. In the distance, I could see people watching. Some were crying, others were praying.

Kim Cheolyang was singing a hymn with them. Oh worms, germs, and whatever, they were celebrating my death.

"Are you laughing?"

Frowning, Lee Cheoldoo grabbed my throat with both hands. With a crack, my breathing was cut off in an instant.

I suddenly realized that there was no one in this story that I knew.

[There is 1 minute remaining.]

There was no righteous Lee Hyunsung here, no Yoo Sangah stepping up for the weak, no Lee Gilyoung collecting worms. There was no Jung Heewon standing up to villains, no Yoo Joonghyuk going insane from repeated regressions, and.....

The oxygen supply to my head was rapidly diminishing, and my entire body felt weak. The moment my vision went dark, I heard a dull noise. Through my blurred vision, I could see Lee Cheoldoo staggering.

Behind him, someone stood holding a pipe dangerously.

It was someone I knew.

Someone who was more ordinary than any of the other Omniscient Reader's characters.

A man whose only familiarity with the world was the novel he had read for ten years.

My protagonist, who was actually a coward, but had risked death for those he loved time and time again.

「Kim Dokja.」

Once again, I heard a dull noise, and Lee Cheoldoo roared and drove his fist into my face.

As I coughed up blood, Lee Cheoldoo chased after Kim Dokja.

I rubbed my eyes, and the back of what looked like Kim Dokja disappeared, and I saw reader ahjussi running away.

[There are 40 seconds remaining.]

After catching him, Lee Cheoldoo snatched the pipe.

I wiped my lips and ran.

[There are 20 seconds remaining.]

Looking at the pipe he was wielding, I wrapped myself around reader ahjussi and rolled over. A sharp pain shot through my back.

I heard Lee Cheoldoo shout.

"You crazy bastard! I'll kill you!"

[There are 10 seconds remaining.]

"You psychopathic bastard! Now everyone is going to be killed because of you! Everyone—"

I looked up at him and smiled for the first time.

"I don't care."

Lee Cheoldoo's screams mingled with the screams of the people and the pounding of my heart.

[There is 1 second remaining.]

Then.

[The given time has run out.]

[Paid settlement will begin.]

All the surrounding sounds disappeared.

I felt dizzy, like the world was spinning.

I gasped for breath and lifted my head. I blinked, checked my vision, and checked my breathing.

Everything was normal.

The time limit had expired and I wasn't dead.

A faint emotion stirred deep in my chest.

The reader ahjussi who was lying next to me stood up and asked.

"Did..... Did we succeed?"

I nodded. As I slowly opened my mouth, I heard the sound of something collapsing next to me.

It was the giant body of Lee Cheoldoo, his head missing.

The startled reader ahjussi shuddered and muttered.

"Huh.....?"

Beyond Lee Cheoldoo's giant body, the desolate landscape of Geumho Station was revealed.

The first thing I saw was the Life Leader Kim Cheolyang.

He was saying something to me. I couldn't hear his voice, but it wasn't hard to imagine the words.

「My God.」

I then looked at Lee Hyekyung, who was bringing yogurt to her son, Jeong Hancheol, who was meeting his girlfriend, and Ji Hyungdong, who was going to run a chicken restaurant with his wife.

I wanted to ask them.

「Does anyone here know the meaning of '1,863'?」

Kim Cheolyang's head exploded with a puff.

「Of course, no one knows.」

Starting with him, people's heads exploded everywhere.

Lee Hyekyung, Jeong Hancheol, Ji Hyungdong.....

The characters' heads were disappearing one by one, as if they had never existed in the first place.

I staggered toward Kim Cheolyang.

Looking at the empty space where Kim Cheolyang's head used to be, I tried to recall his face, which was already hard to remember.

But I couldn't.

Because I never described their faces.

They were not used in 'Omniscient Reader'.

People who were set up in advance, but never found a home, and remained just as settings.

「Cult of Life.」

In the setting, the 'Cult of Life' was a cult that recognized only those they designated as 'life', and slaughtered everyone else.

Lee Hyekyung, Jeong Hancheol, and Ji Hyungdong..... The same was true for everyone in this story.

「The people in this zone become part of the 'Cult of Life' in every round that they survive.」

Those who have not been recorded will never be recorded.

They will remain a 'setting' here, unread by anyone.

「Just because someone designed them to be evil.」

I looked over to see reader ahjussi mouth open in disbelief. The scenery of Geumho Station was imprinted in his eyes.

Looking at him, I thought.

I was being thought.

「I want to write a novel.」

The blood that spilled covered the entire station like spilled ink.

Everywhere I looked, there was no one left alive but us.

Slowly, my legs became weak.

The reader ahjussi muttered in disbelief.

"How can this....."

"....."

"You were trying to save those people, right.....?"

I answered after a pause.

"Yes."

In truth, halfway through, Operation Germ had been doomed to failure.

No matter how I thought about it, there was no way the constellations would find this development amusing.

Still, I didn't let them know.

With that, Kim Cheolyang, the Cult of Life members, and Lee Cheoldoo didn't appear in the story.

I don't know about the rest of the world, but the history of Geumho Station won't be much different from the main story.

「There is only one survivor in this area.」

I looked up at the ceiling. In a blinding flash of light, Bihyung looked down at me. His expression was one of genuine admiration.

Looking into the dokkaebi's story-drunk eyes, I muttered a classic Yoo Joonghyuk line.

"Fuck the Star Stream."

I knew what was about to happen to me.

I could feel the blood trickling down the back of my head.

[The will of the <Star Stream> is looking at you.]

This goddamned world, which only shows what the constellations want, is so contrived in directing.

That's why my head will explode after everyone else's.

[A few constellations are looking at you.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is looking at you with amusement.]

I tried to ease the rising terror of death.

I'm not scared. When I die, even this fear will be gone anyway.

I looked at reader ahjussi one last time.

"Ahjussi."

His hands shook as if he knew what was about to happen to me. Tears pooled in his eyes.

"Oh, no, mate. No."

I wanted to survive, at least until I met Kim Dokja, until I saw the hero of my story.

But maybe.

"Make sure you live to see the end."

Maybe I already have.

I prayed that he would live long enough to see the end of this story.

I felt something drain from my head, and then a pure white darkness washed over me.

In my final moments, I thought about how this scene would be written if it were a novel.

What would the reader say about my death, you might wonder as well.

They'd think I deserved to die.

I could think of any number of reasons why I deserved to die.

For not killing the first bug I caught.

For failing to take more control of the situation.

For having faltering sympathy for the characters I created.

.....

Because the story is Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

No matter how many reasons I listed, there were enough reasons to die.

I'm dying because I haven't proven my worth.

That's why I was surprised.

Why.

I'm not dead yet, am I?

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk37: Looking forward to the next chapter. |

I snapped out of it.

I wiped the blood dripping from my head. It was a cut I got from Lee Cheoldoo earlier. Luckily, it wasn't too deep.

My mind became clear again. My breathing and pulse were normal.

「I'm not dead.」

Why the hell?

[You have cleared the first scenario.]

I looked down at my bloody palms.

I hadn't killed a bug.

The bacteria were not recognized as living beings.

But how.

[You have slaughtered a total of 19 creatures.]

[Slaughter story: 19 human beings.]

[You have earned 1,900 coins.]

[You succeeded in killing in a unique way that no one has ever attempted before.]

[A few constellations marvel at your killing strategy.]

When I turned my head, I saw ahjussi's face, and as if in disbelief, he was crying and holding my hand.

As I looked at him, I realized what had happened to me.

[The <Star Stream> has acknowledged your unique way of killing.]

[You incited people with false information, only for them to 'kill themselves'.]

.

.

.

[The Bureau has given you limited recognition for your way of killing.]

[The Bureau has named your way of killing as 'demagogy killing'.]

.

.

.

[Some constellations have sponsored you for the new scenario you have shown.]

[4,000 coins have been earned.]

[You have accomplished a non-existent achievement.]

[You have accomplished the 'Demagogue Killer' achievement for a phenomenal slaughter.]

I turned my head and saw my reflection in the screen door.

He was asking.

「Did you really not see this coming?」

Kim Cheolyang, the member of the 10 Evils who existed only in the setting, did not survive at Geumho Station because of this man.

I knew who he was now.

He was the owner of Geumho Station before Kim Dokja came.

A man who freely used propaganda, manipulated people, and formed a 'group' in the shortest amount of time.

An incarnation that had survived some rounds of 'Ways of Survival' and ascended to the top of the Ten Evils.

The reason why this man is a character with narrow eyes that I have never seen before.

It was because I never described his appearance.

Because this character...

「"I love them all, except for guys like....."」

Because he was the only one of the many characters in the whole Omniscient Reader that I didn't like.

I heard the sound of a drum being torn from somewhere, and the lights flickered harshly. I heard the sound of something creaking and crumbling.

I could tell by the sound alone.

[Main Scenario #1 — Proof of Value has ended.]

It was the sound of reality as we knew it crumbling.

[300 coins have been acquired as a basic clearance reward.]

[100 coins have been reduced for the channel usage fee.]

[Additional compensations settlement will begin.]

One episode was ending, and the next was beginning.

[The character you are currently possessing is 'Demagogue Cheon Inho'.]

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Author's Note

The side story is starting.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

# 564 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (1)

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「When you say 'kill', do you mean I have to kill them myself?」

Although it doesn't appear in Omniscient Reader, there is an incarnation that solved the first scenario using 'suicide' in 'Ways of Survival'.

Fingersnapper 'Christina Page'.

A former legal hypnosis specialist at the FBI, she solved the first scenario by brainwashing a criminal she was working with into committing suicide.

'Demagogy Killing.'

The way I was credited was similar.

The characters who believed the misinformation chose to 'take their own lives' because of me, and I was credited for an 'indirect murder' for causing the mass suicide.

I wondered if such a murder was even possible, but it happened.

[The character you are currently possessing is 'Demagogue Cheon Inho'.]

Perhaps it's because he's the one I'm possessing.

[Your attunement to the character you are currently possessing is too high.]

[Disable some of the possessed character's attributes.]

As I looked down at my bloody hands, I slowly realized what I had done.

If I hadn't possessed Cheon Inho, what would have happened to the people of Geumho Station?

「Wouldn't they have been killed by Cheon Inho the same way anyway?」

If so, was it the writer Lee Hakhyun or the character Cheon Inho who killed them?

In this world, am I a murderer who killed people or a writer who described the death of a character?

As I breathed in and out, my complicated thoughts quickly subsided.

[The exclusive attribute is activated.]

Now was not the time for moral tension.

I would encounter people like Life Leader Kim Cheolyang many times in the future.

I must continue to live in this world by killing people.

[Compensation settlement is delayed due to an unexpected scenario check. Please wait.]

At least until I figure out the secrets of this world.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is interested in you.]

[The constellations of the 'absolute evil' system are interested in you.]

[A few constellations are curious about your name.]

I came to my senses as the messages from the constellations began in earnest.

[The constellations of the 'absolute evil' system are backing you.]

[Constellations have sponsored you 300 coins.]

I had the attention of the constellations of the 'absolute evil' system.

Apparently, they had interpreted my 'demagogy killing' in a malicious way.

This did not bode well.

This would make it harder for me to get sponsorship from the constellations of the 'absolute good' system.

[The constellations of the 'absolute good' system are shocked by the local tragedy.]

[The constellations of the 'absolute good' system are moved by your heroism.]

Huh?

[The constellations of the 'absolute good' system are impressed by your good intentions in trying to save everyone.]

[Constellations have sponsored you 300 coins.]

[The constellations of the 'absolute evil' system are questioning what the hell they are talking about.]

Everyone seems to have their own interpretation of this.

"Hey..... are you all right?"

I turned my head to see the worried-looking reader ahjussi.

"Uh, yeah. And you?"

"I'm fine. I hope so."

The reader ahjussi's face was still white. It would be even stranger if he was still sane under the circumstances.

I stiffly bowed my head in greeting.

"Thank you for earlier. You saved my life."

Honestly, the credit should go to him, not me.

He fought against the Cheoldoo Group's boss to save me with a physique that was at least as good as Kim Dokja's.

[The constellations of the 'absolute good' system's eyes are shining.]

However, he was actually embarrassed.

"No, rather, I owe you. If you hadn't saved me, I would be lying there too, but..... the germs worked for you?"

Ahjussi still doesn't know that I 'demagogy killed' the people of Geumho Station.

I thought about just being honest, but I figured it was probably better not to.

"I don't know either, they also killed germs together....."

"Maybe only your germs died? Although I don't know if that's possible....."

He seemed to conclude that was the only answer. Instead of answering him, I looked toward the bodies.

He interpreted my silence and he quickly added.

"It's not your fault, you did the best you could."

The reader ahjussi let out a small sigh, looked at me with a pitying look on his face, and then looked back at the dead people and muttered.

"Honestly..... they didn't seem to be good people."

I felt guilty for trying to deceive a naive middle-aged man, but I thought it was better than telling him the truth.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' admires your wickedness.]

[The constellation 'Woman Who Pours Water into a Bottomless Pit' is touched by your heart.]

Which character does this ahjussi possess, anyway?

Given his unfamiliar appearance, I'm pretty sure he's an extra.

Come to think of it, I have the skill to figure it out.

[The information of this person can't be read in 'Character List'.]

[This person is a 'character' but not a 'character'.]

I see what the situation is.

This man's body is a character, but the man's spirit that's possessing it is not.

[The exclusive skill has been activated.]

It was then that a strange message popped up.

[The exclusive skill 'Readers' Comments List' has been activated.]

Readers' Comments List?

[Do you want to use 'Readers' Comments List' in this person?]

I nodded tentatively.

[Checking the reader's profile information.]

> ID: wldbsdldkQk80
>
> Platform: Textia
>
> Total Comments : 32
>
> Reader level : 16

[You can use coins to view the comments written by this reader.]

[Number of comments currently available for free: 3.]

No, I can see this?

I looked at the sorrowful ahjussi's profile.

Should I see just one?

> Jiyoon-ah, are you reading a novel in your room again?
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Chapter 1)

Ahjussi's first comment immediately came to my mind.

The story about having a daughter must be true.

Just one more.

> Jiyoon-ah, open the door. I know you're reading the novel.
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Chapter 7)

I thought I knew how this ahjussi came to find Omniscient Reader.

I've already seen two, so let's just take a look at the rest.

> How do I pay for the next episode?
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Chapter 25)

[Pay coins to see additional comments.]

For some reason, I felt like I could trust this man.

Feeling unnecessarily apologetic, I held out my hand to him.

"Allow me to introduce myself."

"Okay."

"My name is Cheon Inho."

I could see him flustered by my words.

I pointed a finger at my face and smiled weakly.

"That's his name."

"Oh, I see, that sounds like a name I've heard before....."

He didn't seem to recognize Cheon Inho.

"He's the villain in the beginning, at Geumho Station."

"Oh.....!"

"Yeah. That's right, the bad guy."

He had other nicknames, such as 'the one to be torn to pieces' and 'someone to burn to death with Hellfire', but I didn't say those.

Ahjussi's face had already turned pale.

"W-what should we do then?"

"It's still early, so there's room for renewal, right? What about you? Who are you?"

"I'm Lee Dansoo..... it says."

That seems to be the name of the person ahjussi's possessing.

Lee Dansoo, Lee Dansoo.

I didn't remember anything off the top of my head.

By the way, if he knows the name of the person he's possessing, can he see his attribute window?

"I'll give you my attributes and skills....."

"Wait, you can't say things like that."

"What? Oh, yeah."

The old man came to his senses as if he had remembered something.

"You sound just like Kim Dokja, hehe."

"Yeah. It's better to act like him right now."

"Did you finish reading 'that novel'?"

"Yes."

Well, technically, I didn't read it, I wrote it.

"Then everyone who read that novel is like us....."

I suddenly realized what he was thinking.

"Don't worry too much. I'm sure they all survived, just like us."

Especially his daughter.

She didn't study, she just read Omniscient Reader, so she 100% survived. The old man smiled weakly.

"Thank you."

"Shall we call ourselves by the names we just mentioned from now on?"

"All right."

He nodded, his eyes slightly relaxed.

It wasn't like we'd had a conversation where he'd asked me who my favorite was, but I felt like we'd suddenly formed a plausible bond.

But that was the end of our fraternity.

[Survivors from the areas 3-4 of Geumho Station: Cheon Inho, Lee Dansoo. A total of 2 survivors.]

The system message that had been interrupted began to play again.

[Additional compensation settlement will begin.]

[200 coins have been earned as additional compensation.]

Subsequently, Bihyung appeared out of thin air. I didn't know what it was, but it was a sign that I had finally solved the first scenario's many problems.

[It's really weird. There were some unusual areas, but none of them solved the scenario in this way..... I never thought you could use the <Star Stream>'s 'directing system' in this way.....]

Bihyung looked down at me and grumbled for a while, before smiling wryly and saying.

[Anyway, congratulations, you passed the first scenario with flying colors.]

I already knew what Bihyung was going to say next. Probably the same goes for the man next to me.

[Now, shouldn't there be a reward for overcoming the hardships? As a reward for the first scenario, you're entitled to the sponsorship of the 'constellations'. Waahhh! How about it? Aren't you looking forward to it?]

We were about to embark on the first key event of 'Omniscient Reader', the Sponsor Selection.

However, Bihyung scratched his head.

[Hmm, that's weird. You are not surprised nor confused.....]

Of course not, we already knew that.

You'll be just like me after you've said the same line a hundred times.

[If you haven't realized by now, you are incredibly weak, and if you are thrown into the scenarios that will take place.....]

You won't be able to catch a single ground rat.

I know.

Bihyung gave his speech with an expression of bewilderment as he saw me yawning, stopping only when he heard the constellations' bitter comments.

[A few constellations are tired of Bihyung's explanations.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' urges him to get on with it!]

The constellations twinkled above Bihyung's head, which seemed to brighten at first glance.

I wonder how many people have gathered for this <Sponsor Selection>?

[Anyway, the constellations are impatient. Let's get started!]

It was still very early in the story, so I didn't expect any great constellations to come.

There's a possibility that a great constellation like the Great Sage Heaven's Equal or Uriel will appear to Kim Dokja, but that's only because he was the protagonist.

At best, I'll have the 'Monarch of the Small Fries' or something.

I didn't expect it.

I really didn't expect that much.

But.....

It won't be Great Sage, but..... there could be a good constellation, right?

I had a really hard time.....

And a screen popped up in front of me.

[There are a total of 10 constellations waiting for your choice.]

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Author's Note

Doki doki

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 565 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (2)

Wait. How many?

**<Sponsor Selection>**

—Please select your sponsor.

—Your chosen sponsor will be your strong supporter.

1. Monarch of the Small Fries

2. Dragon Lying Down

3. Sneaky Schemer

.....

I blinked, dumbfounded.

This many people applied to be my sponsor?

Where did they get the word?

[The constellations are awaiting your choice.]

I couldn't tell. I guess we'll have to see who's here first.

There are a lot of constellations that applied, and they may not be worthy.

First up is the 'Monarch of the Small Fries'.

I expected this one.

In Omniscient Reader, he was the sponsor behind the acting leader on Geumho Station, Bang Cheolsoo. After the beginning, he disappeared.

In other words, he was not worth considering.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is glaring at you.]

The second was the 'Dragon Lying Down'.

This one is the Crouching Dragon(臥龍), 'Zhu Ge Kong Ming'. He had excellent stats for a narrative-grade constellation.

He must have been impressed with my killing strategy, but unfortunately, I didn't plan on choosing him here.

[The constellation 'Dragon Lying Down' is frowning.]

Next up is..... Huh?

For a moment, I thought I'd misread the modifier.

Third, the 'Sneaky Schemer'.

I thought it was 'Secretive Plotter'.

An imitation?

Thinking about it, I couldn't recall a constellation with this modifier.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says he's very strong and you should choose him.]

The way he's talking, he's not even worthy of the modifier. I wonder if he's actually copying the 'Secretive Plotter'.

'Secretive Plotter' is an exceptional case, but as Kim Dokja says, it's unlikely that a constellation with such a poor modifier is a strong one.

| |
|---|
| 4. Abyssal Black Flame Dragon |

I sucked in an involuntary breath.

Who?

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' came after hearing rumors about you.]

Abyssal Black Flame Dragon.

The guy who was the sponsor behind the Black Flames Empress Han Sooyoung in Omniscient Reader, and one of the 'first four' of Bihyung's channel.

It's been a long time since I've seen that modifier.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' tells you to decide quickly.]

Now that I think about it, he's been all over Kim Namwoon, Han Sooyoung, Kim Dokja, and Yoo Joonghyuk before.

Then, does that mean I'm also a main character?

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is cancelling his 'Sponsor Application'.]

[The number of options for sponsors has been reduced to 9.]

Short-tempered bastard.

I wasn't planning on choosing him anyway, so it wasn't a shame.

There were still six more to go.

5. Nail-Eating Rat

I suddenly regretted rejecting Black Flame Dragon.

6. Primordial Cow

7. Tiger Eating Rice Cakes

Not yet.

There are still three more to go.

8. Pig in a Brick House

9. Dog Who Threw Himself Into the Flames

What the hell is going on here?

Don't tell me there's some kind of 'zodiacal pickup only' event.

I closed my eyes, took a light, deep breath, and muttered my own lucky charm.

「I am Kim Dokja.」

I checked the last constellation.

10. ???

Three question marks?

Can this be a modifier?

Just as I was thinking about it, a lightning bolt flashed in my head and the scene of a dark theater came to mind.

「"What's the identity of the constellation represented by '???' in Omniscient Reader?"」

Sure enough, the question had come up in <Kim Dokja's Banquet> before.

I knew the answer.

In the entire Omniscient Reader, there was only one constellation with the modifier '???'

He is the highest being who watches over everything in the universe.

He is the sponsor behind the regressor Yoo Joonghyuk, who only covets the next story.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is looking at you.]

The protagonist of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

I looked up at the ceiling with trembling eyes.

「The Oldest Dream.」

---

The entity called "The Oldest Dream" in Omniscient Reader is divided into two.

One is the 'young Kim Dokja' who appears at the beginning of the novel.

The second is the 'adult Kim Dokja', who inherits the modifier in the second half of the novel.

Unless I'm being fooled by a high-level trick, this is clearly the beginning of the novel.

Above all, the presence of Bihyung and 'Daepong Girls' High School' Lee Jihye proved this fact.

If it was after the end of the main story of 'Omniscient Reader', there was no way Bihyung or Lee Jihye would have appeared like this.

「So, is '???' the 'young Kim Dokja'?」

Come to think of it, it doesn't make sense.

Throughout the course of 'Omniscient Reader', 'Young Kim Dokja' rarely interfered in the story, except to regress Yoo Joonghyuk.

He probably doesn't even realize he's a god.

And now he's making me a 'Sponsor Application', a man who doesn't even appear in 'Ways of Survival'?

Even when he's already Yoo Joonghyuk's sponsor?

「In that case, is '???' the 'adult Kim Dokja'?」

Even if I thought so, it didn't make sense either.

At the end of Omniscient Reader, the 'adult Kim Dokja' had his soul split into molecules and scattered into the universe.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is awaiting your choice.]

A cold tension radiated down my spine.

"You..... Who are you?"

I ask, not really expecting an answer, but.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is looking at you.]

My breathing stopped, and a chill spread through my body.

With a tsuchuchut, my entire body began to glow blue, followed by a terrible pain as if my spine was on fire, engulfing my consciousness.

.

.

.

【■■■ ■■.】

【This is ■■■ playground.】

【You may not intervene in ■■■ story.】

【Even if you ■■ ■■■ ■■■■■■.】

.

.

.

When I opened my eyes again, ahjussi was shaking me.

"Wake up, mate!"

My body shook helplessly.

I came to my senses with a start.

Blood trickled from my nose.

What the hell? What just happened?

In my daze, ahjussi continued to shake me.

"I think I'm going to throw up....."

"Oh, I'm sorry. I just saw you with white eyes suddenly. What happened with the Sponsor Selection?"

"Sponsor Selection.....?"

[There are 10 seconds left to complete the Sponsor Selection.]

Holy shit.

I quickly looked at the Sponsor Selection window.

And then.

| 9. Dog Who Threw Himself Into the Flames |
|---|

I wondered what had happened.

Apparently, the '10th' option that was visible a moment ago has disappeared.

[There are 5 seconds left to complete the Sponsor Selection.]

I didn't have much time to think.

Should I choose the best constellation or.....

I pondered until the very last second and made my decision.

[Sponsor Selection has ended.]

Apparently, this world is not the 'Omniscient Reader' I knew.

I couldn't quite put my finger on it, but this world was twisted in some important way.

[You haven't selected a sponsor.]

For now, I felt the need to wait and see what would happen. I could always choose a sponsor again later.

As long as I somehow survived.

"Mate?"

"Yes."

"Did you choose?"

I shook my head.

Dansoo ahjussi shook his head as if agreeing with my response.

"Oh, come to think of it, Kim Dokja....."

"No, no, I couldn't decide, there were a lot of good constellations."

It's a lie, but I had to say it like this.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is relieved that that was it.]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' is relieved.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' asks to be picked next time.]

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' nods saying that it can happen.]

By saying it like this, I avoided the criticism of the constellation that made a Sponsor Application.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' accuses you of being pathetic for missing the opportunity.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is looking at you with narrowed eyes.]

Luckily, that was a good reaction.

"How about you?"

"It was pretty hard for me, too."

"How many constellations applied?"

"Four."

I was honestly surprised.

I mean, he have done some pretty unusual things, but four?

"Did you get any good constellations?"

"There were some names I recognized."

"Who?"

I was a little nervous.

Still, he had done the good deed of saving me, so there was a chance that if he was lucky, a nice constellation would appear.

Luckily, the Korean Peninsula had a lot of good ones, so even he only got the 'Bald General' or 'King Heungmu', the initial scenarios would be fine.

"That..... 'Commander of the Red Cosmos'."

"Aha, Cosmos....."

I replied nonchalantly, then snapped my head up.

"'Commander of the Red Cosmos'?"

"Yes....."

I couldn't believe my eyes as I looked at the nervous-looking Dansoo ahjussi.

This was because the star he was referring to was a narrative-grade constellation. Commander of the Red Cosmos.

'Archangel Jophiel' of <Eden>.

A constellation comparable to Uriel, who visited the 1,863rd round's world line with Kim Dokja and later became the ruler of <Eden>.

With a single blow of Jophiel's stigma, lower-level demons would be destroyed without a trace.

"Is she a great constellation?"

"Yes. She's great."

"Actually, I don't remember much about her..... The novel has a lot of difficult words, and it's been a while since I read it....."

I asked, trying to calm the slightly quivering corners of my mouth.

"And the second one?"

This time he sounded confident.

"'Goryeo's First Sword'."

I let out a gasp.

Goryeo's First Sword, 'Cheok Jungyeong'.

The so-called 'Swordmaster Cheok', a powerful Korean constellation.

Considering its late-game potential, it wasn't a bad choice instead of a narrative class one.

"Wow, that's awesome. What about the third one?"

At that moment, Dansoo ahjussi's face looked strangely dignified.

The reason was soon revealed.

"The third one was 'God of Wine and Ecstasy'."

I wondered if I had misheard.

"Who?"

"God of Wine and Ecstasy....."

"Really? You're not lying, are you?"

"Why would I lie?"

Ahjussi looked frustrated.

As for me, I wanted to use [Lie Detection.]

No, this doesn't make sense.

Jophiel, Goryeo's First Sword.

And God of Wine and Ecstasy, Dionysus?

Who is Dionysus?

Isn't he one of the twelve gods of the great nebula <Olympus>, and a powerful narrative-grade constellation that has sided with Kim Dokja since the beginning of Omniscient Reader?

No, why did those constellations appear?

I was happy for him, but I was still a little envious and upset.

"Who was the last one? No way the last one....."

"Well, the last constellation took me by surprise."

Surprise?

For a moment, I thought about '???'

Did that option come up for him too?

"It's a constellation called 'Sneaky Schemer'."

It turned out to be the Secretive Plotter imitation.

Luckily, that last one wasn't a big deal.

"He came to me, too."

He sounded strangely disappointed.

"May I ask how it was for you?"

"I had about ten of them."

"What, ten?"

"Yeah, well, I didn't get to pick anyone."

"May I ask which ones they were?"

"Well, the Black Flame Dragon and....."

"Black Flame Dragon!"

Dansoo ahjussi nodded, his eyes shining like a child's.

However, no matter how much I thought about it, there was no other constellation worth mentioning than the Black Flame Dragon.

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' is frowning.]

I thought for a moment, then decided to do the smart thing and save everyone's pride.

"And a dragon as famous as the Black Flame Dragon."

"That's incredible."

[The constellation 'Dragon Lying Down' is moved by your words and has sponsored you 100 coins.]

"And..... There were a couple of constellations on the level of the Prisoner of the Golden Headband....."

"On the level of the Prisoner of the Golden Headband....."

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' has sponsored you 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' has sponsored you 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' has sponsored you 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'Dog Who Threw Himself into the Flames' has sponsored you 100 coins.]

The Prisoner of the Golden Headband is a strong monkey.

He doesn't know, but they're probably strong tigers, strong cows, strong rats, and strong dogs, so I was not entirely wrong.

Seeing them rejoice made me feel good, too.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is looking at you in disbelief.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is calling out for the 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband'.]

.....No way.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' has entered the channel.]

No, wait.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' has left the channel.]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' has left the channel.]

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' has left the channel.]

[The constellation 'Dog Who Threw Himself into the Flames' has left the channel.]

I felt like I could hear Bihyung's scream from somewhere.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' asks where they all went.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' says he didn't see them because he was at home.]

Even as the channel fizzled, Dansoo ahjussi, who was sitting next to me, kept giving me thumbs up.

"Wow, that's amazing, all those big constellations."

"No, but who did you pick?"

There were three main choices.

Jophiel, Cheok Jungyeong and Dionysus.

All three are amazing constellations, so it was a matter of preference.

No matter who you pick, you're guaranteed a solid foundation for at least until the mid-game scenarios.

Suddenly, a halo seemed to emanate from Dansoo ahjussi.

Upon closer inspection, he was a bit old, but there was an unmistakable gleam in his eyes.

Moreover, he had read the whole Omniscient Reader.

Wait, this.....

Is he the 'protagonist'?

Just as the protagonist of Omniscient Reader was Kim Dokja, maybe the protagonist of this story is this ahjussi.

The situation was similar to that of Kim Dokja, as there were three big names attached to him from the very beginning.

My heart suddenly began to race.

If this ahjussi is the protagonist.....

I thought of the first sentence about Dansoo ahjussi.

"Sometimes I thought to myself. What if I were the main character."

Sure enough, I nodded my head in agreement with the exquisite protagonist-like remarks.

"If I were Kim Dokja, who would I have chosen in the first 'Sponsor Selection'?"

In the first Sponsor Selection, Kim Dokja received a huge love letter from Uriel, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, the Black Flame Dragon, and the Secretive Plotter, but he

made the mistake of not choosing anyone.

"I was surprised. I would have picked the strongest one, of course."

"That's usually the case."

Kim Dokja had read the 3,149 chapters of 'Ways of Survival' that had 50,000 characters per chapter, and since he was a madman who memorized them all, he could survive with that choice.

However, Dansoo ahjussi had only read 551 chapters of 'Omniscient Reader' (which had 5,000 characters per chapter), and even then, he didn't understand most of them.

"Yes..... I just picked the strongest constellation, as usual."

"I think I know who you picked."

Dansoo ahjussi smiled and nodded.

"Yes. I've forgotten a lot of other things, but I do remember the name of this constellation, because it's the strongest in the entire novel."

He was suddenly talking a lot, and I felt a little uneasy.

Come to think of it, ahjussi didn't even remember who Cheon Inho was.

"Ahjussi. Sorry to disappoint you, but the 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' is strong, but she's not the strongest....."

"I didn't pick the red flower or whatever."

"The 'God of Wine and Ecstasy' is also a narrative-grade. As you know, above the narrative level, there's the myth level....."

"I don't like alcohol."

I said, quickly scanning my surroundings and lowering my voice.

"Ahjussi, I'm Korean too, so I'm very fond of 'Goryeo's First Sword', but....."

"I'm not such a patriot that I would call Cheok Jungyeong the strongest either."

"Then who the hell did you choose?"

Ahjussi's eyes, which felt like guns, flashed with madness.

"Jiyoon has always said that this constellation is the best in Omniscient Reader. That she'd end up getting married with him someday."

Marry?

"'A man who endured the tragedy of endless regressions and finally saw the end of this world', Jiyoon had that on a poster in her room."

I suddenly realized what had happened.

No, no, no.

No way.

There's no way a reader of my novel would get that confused.

But Dansoo ahjussi was smiling confidently, like Kim Dokja who had already broken through the [Final Wall.]

"I've picked the strongest one, the 'Sneaky Schemer'."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is smiling brightly.]

I suddenly began to think that he was like Han Myungoh, who chose 'Lame Trickster'.

[The restriction on this area has been lifted!]

In the distance, I could see men with pipes running toward us.

[The next scenario is about to begin.]

Maybe we'll die before we meet Kim Dokja.

---

Author's Note

No way!

---

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 566 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (3)

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As I watched the men approaching with a fearsome momentum, I suddenly realized that I was in Omniscient Reader.

This is 'Geumho Station', where a series of horrific murders have taken place.

The men with the pipes were most likely members of the 'Cheoldoo Group', the mainstream group at Geumho Station.

In a fortunate twist of fate, the original owner of Geumho Station was the character I possessed, Cheon Inho.

In other words, Cheon Inho became the owner of Geumho Station after he defeated all of those terrifying men from the Cheoldoo Group.

How the hell did you do it, Cheon Inho?

In the distance, I could see the men checking our area freeze in their tracks, because there was blood everywhere.

I quickly asked Dansoo ahjussi.

"Ahjussi, did you get a stigma?"

There are two main types of techniques in Omniscient Reader.

One is the 'skill' that the incarnation learns themselves.

The other is the 'stigma', which are powers bestowed by their constellation.

"Uh..... I don't think I can use it yet....."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is using a ploy that does not readily lend the stigma to make the incarnation strong.....]

It was my fault for expecting something.

When I looked up, I saw the figure of Bihyung, who was hurriedly sweet-talking the constellations.

[Oh my. How did this person end up on my channel.....]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is picking his ears as if it's a nuisance.]

[By the way, if you do something like that, the other constellations will.....]

This was the first meeting between the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and Bihyung.

I decided to try to win Bihyung over, because if I was going to make it through the scenario ahead, cunning cooperation with that crazed monster was essential.

'Dokkaebi communication.'

[Activating the 'dokkaebi communication'.]

'Bihyung. I have something to tell you.'

Fortunately, Bihyung accepted the dokkaebi communication.

—What is it? How did you know how to connect the dokkaebi communication?

You forced me to use it when you caught the bug earlier.

I said, hiding my true intentions.

'I want to make a deal with you.'

Bihyung narrowed his eyes as if he were dumbfounded by my out-of-the-blue proposal.

—A deal?

'Yes. A deal.'

Bihyung was speechless for a moment. How many more seconds passed like that?

—Cocky bastard, you're lucky I didn't blow your brains out right now.

He had a hint of amusement in his voice. I answered casually.

'If you do that, you'll lose all the subscribers of your channel, and I think you've already lost a few.'

—What. What?

Bihyung won't be able to kill me now, because I've gradually gotten some constellations interested in me.

I took the risk of attracting the attention of the constellations to take advantage of this.

'Hear what I have to say first, what I'd like to propose is.....'

—Do you also want a 'stream contract'?

I paused, then asked back.

'What are you talking about?'

—Hmm? I guess you don't. I've got a couple of kids who keep asking me for that, saying they were going to make me the Dokkaebi King or something.

Suddenly, I felt a headache.

It was obvious who the requesters were.

'So what did you do?'

—Naturally, I refused. There were a lot of strange children, suddenly showing themselves catching ichthyosaurs, asking me to open the Dokkaebi Bag..... They think they're my friends.

Oh, dear readers.

'Why didn't you do it?'

—Do you think I'm crazy?

If this was the original story, and there was only one otherworldly reader, we wouldn't have this problem.

Kim Dokja was the only reader, and his every action was bound to attract the attention of Bihyung.

But not anymore.

Besides Dansoo ahjussi, there will be other people who cleared the scenario before the 'bug' maneuver is blocked, and there will be other readers who will try to use the same hidden pieces that Kim Dokja used.

Too many readers start doing the same thing, so Bihyung has become wary of them.

.....What on earth happened to the real Kim Dokja?

I sighed and opened my mouth.

'Actually, I was going to ask you to sign a stream contract.'

—I'm leaving.

'I'll give you a 7:3 ratio. That's the industry's default settlement ratio.'

I didn't hear the communication go off, which meant that Bihyung was still listening to me.

I poured out my cards one after another.

'I know that a contract between an incarnation and a streamer dokkaebi is not against the rules, and I'll do my best not to let anyone find out.'

'Throughout the contract period, I will not cooperate with other dokkaebi channels without your permission, and I will refrain from any personal behavior that might offend the constellations.'

'During the contract period, until my death, I will not accept any sponsor contracts.'

If this was a publishing contract, I would never have done this.

But now I had no choice.

I have to live.

Bihyung, who was listening to me, asked.

—You, what do you know?

'I know a few things.'

—The other guys wanted me to do it for 10:0 ratio, and I'd only get the commission.

'They must not know much about the industry. It's a tough job, being a babysitter. Reacting to the Executive Branch dokkaebis, collecting the back coins when there's a probability request, and how much jealousy there is among the low-level dokkaebi.'

—You..... Are you a dokkaebi?

'I know your industry well.'

Ji Eunyu used to say similar things when she was complaining about management.

—I-I won't sign a <Stream Contract> with you. How can I trust a guy who's barely cleared the first scenario.....

I wondered if it was an illusion, but Bihyung's voice was a bit more gentle. It's time to push in.

'But I cleared it in a pretty unique way.'

—It was just luck.

'The sub scenario will start soon, so you can keep an eye on it this time as well.'

—You..... How do you know that? Are you a reincarnator?

Come to think of it, there were reincarnators in Omniscient Reader. I wrote it, but it's a convenient setting.

I shrugged it off.

'Something like that. Anyway, open the sub scenario. It seems like people are coming just in time.'

The pipe men, who had been watching for a while, decided to come up to this side as if they had decided it was worth it.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is amused.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is telling 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' to watch because something funny will happen.]

Bihyung, who had overruled the constellation's rebellion, began to prepare a scenario.

—First of all, I'll see how you do it.

'I won't be waiting too long. Honestly, you're not the only dokkaebi.'

The tendons in Bihyung's head twitched, but I couldn't be bothered to pay attention to him now.

"Hey, you over there."

The pipe men were just around the corner. By the looks of them, these guys are no slouches.

"What?"

"What? Look at this."

In response, a man who looked like the leader stepped forward.

This..... I think I know who he is.

I immediately used [Character List].

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Bang Cheolsoo

Age: 34 years old

Sponsor: Monarch of the Small Fries

Exclusive Attributes: Assault Force Captain (General)

Exclusive Skills: [Dogfight Lv.2], [Bluff Lv.2]

Stigma: [Threaten Lv. 1]

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.5], [Strength Lv.6], [Agility Lv.5], [Magic Power Lv.2]

Overall Evaluation: A common small fry who was lucky to obtain a sponsor. He's just finished the first scenario and is feeling pretty pumped up.

Wow, it's really Bang Cheolsoo.

Who is Bang Cheolsoo..... Anyway, he's the guy who gets beaten to death by Kim Dokja at Geumho Station.

His stats seem to be lower than when Kim Dokja first met him.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is getting excited.]

[The second scenario has arrived!]

"Hyung-nim. Did you get a message?"

"Ah, it looks like a similar message to the one from earlier."

The men from the Cheoldoo Group, still unfamiliar with the scenario, hesitated.

I checked the scenario.

**<Sub Scenario - Domination>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: D

Clear Conditions: Control Geumho Station and become the leader of the area. The scenario ends when more than half of the people recognize you as the leader.

Time Limit: 4 hours

Reward: 500 coins

Failure: —

This is what happened here.

Originally, Kim Dokja was also performing the sub scenario 'Escape' at this time, so it's not strange.

Is this what Cheon Inho was doing?

Bang Cheolsoo sneered and said.

"It's going to be easy this time, take care of the two guys in front."

The shielding of the area had finally been lifted, and in the distance, I could see people snooping around this way.

"Everybody move. Walk carefully."

Blood spattered on the aprons of the approaching men. Presumably, these guys killed everyone and survived the first scenario.

Dansoo ahjussi got tense next to me. He's a reliable ahjussi, not running away even at times like this.

But this time, it was enough with me alone.

No, I have to do this alone.

"Mate?"

"Leave it to me."

The scenario is still very much up in the air.

Even if I didn't necessarily have a good constellation, I wasn't completely out of the fight.

Especially if, like me, you had a lot of support in the first scenario.

[2,700 coins have been invested into 'strength'.]

[Strength Lv.1 → Strength Lv.10]

[Your strength level has increased dramatically!]

I expected it, but I was still surprised.

My stats were really level 1.

[900 coins have been invested into 'physique'.]

[Physique Lv.1 → Physique Lv.4]

This was also level 1.

Cheon Inho, how the hell did you become the leader of Geumho Station?

[900 coins have been invested into 'agility'.]

[Agility Lv.1 → Agility Lv.4]

Still, this will work for now.

I left aside some coins just in case.

[Coins Possessed: 2,900 C]

In the meantime, a small fry leapt forward swinging his pipe at me.

"Look out, asshole!"

I couldn't open my narrow eyes any wider.

I caught the flying pipe with my hand. There was a little pain in my grip, but I managed to snatch the man's pipe away without much difficulty.

"Huh?"

As I watched the panicked man blink stupidly, I gripped the pipe with both hands. The feel of the hard pipe was vivid against my palms.

Normally, I wouldn't have been able to do it, but for Lee Hakhyun now..... No, for Cheon Inho it was no problem.

Kutututuk!

The man's eyes widened as he watched the pipe magically break.

"T-this strength?"

The stat level in 'Omniscient Reader' increases dramatically in units of 10.

This is the power of Strength Lv.10.

I casually tossed the bent pipe to the ground and walked forward.

The panicked Cheoldoo group stumbled backwards.

"Moderation, Bang Cheolsoo."

Bang Cheolsoo's eyes widened in surprise.

"How—"

"It doesn't matter how I know your name."

I said, lightly skimming over the bloodied station.

"The only survivors of this section are me and that man. It's not like we're a bunch of guys with pipes. You know what that means, and you still attack us?"

"T-that—"

"Are you really stupid, or are you pretending to be stupid?"

My strength was at level 10, and my physique and agility were barely above rock bottom. If there was a real group fight, I'd have to spend extra coins.

Biting his lip, Bang Cheolsoo glared at me.

"You seem to have something you're relying on, but I'll make sure you realize you picked the wrong person today."

Again, it didn't go over so simply. After all, he had to save face in front of his subordinates.

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo' has used 'Bluff Lv.2'!]

[Your confidence plummets due to the effect of 'Bluff'.]

Being glared at with such a fearsome face, my heart was pounding. I realized that [Bluff] was a great skill. I would have been fine if I had a [Fourth Wall] like Kim Dokja, but I

didn't.

Of course, that didn't mean I didn't have the means to fight back.

I faced Bang Cheolsoo, hiding my trembling heart.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.2' has been activated!]

There was many different ways to use [Incite], Cheon Inho's exclusive skill. The basic ability, of course, is to literally incite others with words.

However,

[Select a target to incite.]

What if the target weren't 'others'?

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

I will incite myself from now on.

---

Author's Note

We are Singshong

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 567 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (4)

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There is an immutable law that those worthy know.

「A man with narrow eyes is stronger when he opens his eyes.」

I squeezed both eyes shut. Slowly, my eyelids rose.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

['Incite' is effective.]

Little by little, I began to have strange thoughts.

Maybe I really am Yoo Joonghyuk?

['Incite' is in full effect.]

Suddenly, I felt skeptical of everything I was about to do. I don't know why, but I also felt like finding and killing Kim Dokja.

「No, you can't be that Yoo Joonghyuk.」

[The effect of 'Incite' is being adjusted.]

I (lightly) became Yoo Joonghyuk.

Bang Cheolsoo's eyes widened as he met mine.

"Did you really think that Bluff would work?"

It was my voice, but it suddenly sounded cool.

This is how Yoo Joonghyuk feels.

Bang Cheolsoo's [Bluff] didn't even tickle him.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' feels a bizarre fear from you.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' looks at you as if they're offended.]

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is looking at you with strange eyes.]

It seems to have worked, as even the constellations were surprised.

Bang Cheolsoo was visibly flustered when his [Bluff] didn't work, and he clenched his knuckled fists tightly.

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo' has used 'Threaten'.]

[For some unknown reason, 'Threaten' doesn't work on you.]

Finally, a bead of sweat formed on his forehead.

"You're a very strong man."

Even without the [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], I could see through him.

「If you get caught here, you're done for.」

Shall I just end it here?

I'm comfortable with killing all of these guys.

A cursory glance tells me there aren't any other possessed here.

But for some reason, I don't like the idea.

No one likes to kill.

I tried saying this.

"Lee Cheoldoo said he doesn't want you to waste your life in vain."

"How do you know about him?"

"I've heard a lot about you from Cheoldoo."

At my words, Dansoo ahjussi looked at me in surprise.

Bang Cheolsoo looked confused.

"You....."

"I accompanied him to Geumho Station. He said he would introduce me to you."

"I-I didn't hear anything like that from Cheoldoo hyung-nim."

"When did he report such things to you one by one?"

"Cheoldoo hyung-nim..... Where is he?"

Bang Cheolsoo's words suddenly became polite. It was evidence that he was shaking.

Instead of answering, I looked theatrically to my left, where the headless body of Lee Cheoldoo lay.

"I'm sorry."

Bang Cheolsoo staggered toward Lee Cheoldoo's body.

"It was a fitting end for him. He died fighting."

"With whom—"

"Revenge."

At the end of my gaze, the body of the Life Leader stretched out before me.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is watching your story with interest.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' likes the sudden noir.]

Bang Cheolsoo stared at me blankly, then bit his lip tightly.

"How can I believe that?"

"It is your freedom to believe it or not."

"If you're the one who sent Cheoldoo hyung-nim to.....!"

"If you are going to do it, then take revenge on me right now."

Bang Cheolsoo stood up, glaring at me with red eyes.

However, it didn't seem like the behavior of someone who was really motivated.

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo' is looking at you.]

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo' wants to do something unexpected.]

[The activation condition for the exclusive skill '□□' has been met.]

I see.

I think I know a little bit about this skill's activation condition now.

[The exclusive skill '□□' is activated.]

The scenery around me turned colorless, and the people began to stiffen.

As I look at the letters floating around, I realize that it's time to create once again.

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo's attribute is preparing to bloom.]

[You can interfere with character 'Bang Cheolsoo's attribute blooming.]

[Due to the character's low potential, the attribute cannot bloom with a single modification.]

Bang Cheolsoo can't be like Kim Cheolyang.

However, Life Leader Kim Cheolyang was originally part of the Ten Evils and also possessed the attribute of the Crouching Figure.

Bang Cheolsoo, on the other hand, is just an ordinary junkie.

But when the system says it like that, it makes me wonder.

It might be the author's arrogance.

In <Star Stream>, how far can an ordinary extra villain really change?

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

[Describe the next action of 'Bang Cheolsoo'.]

> # Bang Cheolsoo's Change of Heart
>
> 「Bang Cheolsoo, Assault Force Leader of the Cheoldoo Group,
> □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□」
>
> * At your current skill level, you can write a total of 160 additional characters.

160 characters.

I could write 10 more characters than last time.

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield' for a total of 3 minutes.]

This is definitely better than last time.

Because I now know a little bit about this skill.

First of all, this skill can't reproduce 'ridiculous' changes in reality.

For example, a character can't suddenly awaken memories of a previous life as a martial arts master and become your loyal servant.

You're more likely to succeed if you describe a behavior that matches the character's desires.

From the message I received before, it seems that I can make additional changes as I accumulate probability.

[Current Accumulated Probability: 10]

[You can increase the reproduction success rate by getting more probability.]

I don't think I'll be able to make much of a difference with this amount.

I'll write for now.

I painstakingly crammed in a sentence of about 160 characters.

[This story's reproduction success rate is 88%.]

[There's enough probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

Come to think of it, there was this function too.

KimDokja37 or something replies.

I wonder if he's the real Kim Dokja?

Then what's the number 37?

'Yes.'

> rlaehrwk37: I hear the sound of Bang Cheolsoo's washing machine running.
>
> rlaehrwk61: Well, he hasn't really started being an asshole yet.

There was another Kim Dokja?

Anyway, judging by the reactions, it didn't seem like this development would cause any serious problems.

[Successfully recreating the scene.]

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

The letters disappeared into thin air, and the story began again.

I sucked in a breath and spat out the words.

"Life's boring..... Don't you think so?"

「Bang Cheolsoo listened to the words in a daze.」

"....."

「Bang Cheolsoo, the Assault Force Captain of the Cheoldoo Group. He had always despaired over this world. Long before the scenario began, his world was doomed.」

Extras also have their own stories. No matter how inscrutable and mundane it was.

"How long are you going to live as the Assault Force Captain of the Cheoldoo Group?"

"What? What do you know—"

"The world has changed. It's not the one you've always resented, and it's time for the likes of you to make peace with the past."

"....."

"You have a choice. You can follow me, or you can continue to live your pathetic little life."

Bang Cheolsoo's eyes shook faintly.

1,863 regressions.

Throughout Yoo Joonghyuk's regressions in Ways of Survival, Bang Cheolsoo was always the Assault Force Captain of Cheoldoo Group.

He lived as the Assault Force Captain and died as the Assault Force Captain.

He was not given a moment to think about the value or dignity of life.

He should not have been rehabilitated; he had to be pointed out by people and become a trophy for the protagonist to shine.

Hence, this sentence I wrote.

「Do I still have a choice?」

It was a possibility granted to the fabricated villain.

「Could he be my cause?」

Bang Cheolsoo, his mind made up, stood up and said.

"Prove it to me."

Bang Cheolsoo charged at me, fists pumping. It was a desperate move, like he was throwing his life away.

But he didn't mean it.

He had made a choice.

Peoeog!

I threw a light punch to the face of the running man.

Bang Cheolsoo let out an exaggerated scream and fell to the ground.

I hadn't hit him that hard, but he was clever.

"H-hyung-nim!"

As the panicked Cheoldoo Group raised their pipes indignantly toward me, Bang Cheolsoo raised his left hand to wipe his nose.

"Stop."

He looked at me for a long moment, then opened his mouth as if he had been bound by the punch.

"Now that Cheoldoo hyung-nim is dead, I am the acting leader of the Cheoldoo Group. I decide who to follow. Do you all have any complaints?"

"W-we have no complaints."

「I wonder why. For the first time, Bang Cheolsoo felt like he was a 'supporting character' instead of an 'extra'.」

Until now, he was just an extra who lived a few sentences. If the writer wanted him to die, he died, and if he wanted him to live, he lived.

But today, he used his imagination to think about the future.

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo' has a faint sense of trust in you.]

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo' is showing signs of slight evolution.]

Bang Cheolsoo stretched out his hand toward me and asked.

"What's your name?"

I replied, helping such a Bang Cheolsoo to his feet.

"Cheon Inho."

---

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' finds your handling of the situation interesting.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is impressed by the hot noir you showed.]

The Monarch of the Small Fries—that bastard was like that in the main story too. It's ridiculous. The incarnation he was raising yielded to me, and he's still talking nonsense.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is sulking because his incarnation has not been seriously injured.]

I glanced at Bang Cheolsoo, who was leading the way, and hit him in the back of the head.

"Why, why did you do that?"

"There was a bug."

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' has sponsored you 100 coins.]

Bang Cheolsoo glanced at me with trembling eyes, then began to lead me two steps ahead.

"There should be a group of people over there."

[There are currently eleven people in Geumho Station who support you.]

I've got the 10 people from the Cheoldoo Group on my side.

This rate was not bad.

It was then that Dansoo ahjussi, who was walking beside me, cautiously asked.

"You're not really Cheon Inho, are you?"

I smiled and replied.

"I am, for now."

Dansoo ahjussi sighed lightly at my joke.

He looked at the Cheoldoo Group walking ahead of us and asked in a low voice.

"Will it be all right? You know what those guys are like."

"Earlier, you asked me if I would let everyone die."

"But those guys are....."

I understood what he meant.

I know what the Cheoldoo Group is like. They are the ones who will commit the most heinous crimes in the future.

The reason I spared them is simple.

「If you're going to use them the same way, there's no point in using them at all.」

"I'm just using them. We need to collect them quickly to reduce unnecessary disturbances at Geumho Station. If they're going to be enemies, it's easier to keep them under control than to fight them."

"There they are....."

Looking at Dansoo ahjussi nodding his head in understanding, I suddenly remembered a reader's comment.

> —So he got beaten to death at Geumho Station every time Yoo Joonghyuk regressed?

I looked at the back of Bang Cheolsoo's head, which looked a bit grim, and shook my head.

Forget it. Now is not the time for such complicated thoughts.

If Kim Dokja and the other main characters survived the first scenario, they will come to Geumho Station.

If Kim Dokja was eaten by the ichthyosaur like in Omniscient Reader, it would be the group and Yoo Joonghyuk that would arrive here first.

If we wanted to give him a good impression, we'd need to turn these Cheoldoo Group bastards into the guards of Geumho Station.

Bang Cheolsoo stopped walking.

"We're here."

The survivors of the first scenario gathered in the stairwell.

I took a deep breath and studied their faces, one by one.

This is where my 'rehabilitation project' comes into play.

Even though Cheon Inho was a trashy demagogue villain in the original Omniscient Reader, he needed to be reformed into a proper human being here.

Okay, I've decided. First, let's take over Geumho Station.

Next, let's be Yoo Joonghyuk's subordinate.

And then, when Yoo Joonghyuk has had enough of being a sunfish, we'll become Kim Dokja's men.

"Do you understand, unni? Be careful of that man."

The voice came from nowhere, and I reflexively turned around to see a very familiar face.

It was her.

She was at Geumho Station.

But I hadn't expected her to be the first <Kim Dokja's Company> member I encountered.

I ran toward her with excitement.

She is the first sword of the Demon King of Salvation Kim Dokja, and the guardian of <Kim Dokja's Company>.

Sponsored by the archangel Uriel, she is one of the strongest characters in Omniscient Reader.

Jung Heewon, the Judge of Destruction.

After catching my gaze, Jung Heewon looked back at me from afar. I greeted her first.

"Hello!"

"Oh, yeah..... Hi."

Jung Heewon acknowledged my greeting with a faint smile.

She must have nerves of steel to be able to smile like that even though she had just performed the first scenario.

"Which section are you from?"

"Oh, we're in the 3-4."

"You have..... Did something similar happen there?"

"Yes."

Checking my bloody apron, Jung Heewon looked slightly wary.

Just in time, Dansoo ahjussi approached.

"My friend and I didn't kill people, we killed other creatures."

"Oh, really? Actually, I also....."

Jung Heewon stopped talking at that point, glancing around her.

But I realized something was wrong.

「Jung Heewon didn't kill people?」

It couldn't be. In the main story, she must have cleared the scenario normally.

How the hell did she—?

"Excuse me, what's your name? I'm Jung Heewon."

"I'm Cheon Inho."

For some reason, the moment she heard my name, her face hardened.

As she looked at me with her cold eyes, I suddenly remembered something.

In the main part of Omniscient Reader, Jung Heewon killed Cheon Inho by stabbing him through the head at Geumho Station.

As I was touching the top of my head with a chill, Jung Heewon, who had taken a few steps away from me, spoke to someone.

"He showed up just like you said."

"Already? Where?"

"That guy. But is he the real deal?"

"Wow, he looks the part. Wouldn't you know it by looking at him?"

"Umm, I'm not sure."

Looking closer, there was a girl about a foot shorter than Jung Heewon clinging to her side.

"Get a hold of yourself, unni, you shouldn't trust him. What did I say about him earlier? Tell me."

Jung Heewon nodded and replied.

"Bad guy. The guy to be torn to pieces. Someone to burn to death with Hellfire."

.....Where did I hear that before?

---

Author's Note

Thanks.

---

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 568 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (5)

---

"That's right, that's him!"

I activated the skill toward the girl who was confidently gossiping about me to Jung Heewon.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

[The information of this person can't be read in 'Character List'.]

[This person is a 'character' but not a 'character'.]

Oh well.

Then I'll use this.

[Do you want to use 'Reader's Comments List' in this person?]

'Yes.'

['Readers' Comments List' skill level has increased to show the number of upvotes and downvotes for each comment.]

['Readers' Comments List' proficiency level has increased, it will display the 'Number of reads' item now.]

This is only my second time using it and the proficiency has already increased?

I should use this more often.

> ID: alsdn0905
>
> Platform: Sirius
>
> Total Comments: 168
>
> Reader level: 38
>
> Number of reads: 1.8 times
>
> * You can use coins to view the comments written by this reader.
>
> * Number of comments currently available for free: 3.

This was the second reader I met after Dansoo ahjussi.

Since the 'number of reads' count is 1.8, I'm guessing she read the entire Omniscient Reader at least once.

Was she actually a good person?

Let's see what she commented.

> I like Jung Heewon
>
> —Upvotes 3 / Downvotes 1
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 18)

Mmm.....

> From today on, I will do 100 push-ups, 100 squats, and run 10 kilometers every day to become a man worthy of Heewon-nim
>
> —Upvotes 0 Downvotes 5
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 25)

I'm confused as to whether this is serious or an expression.

> Heewon-nim... I love you... Seriously... I love you as much as 3000 squats...
>
> —Upvotes 2 Downvotes 8
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 107)

Man, the number of downvotes just keeps increasing.

[Pay coins to see additional comments.]

[Pay 100 coins to see an additional comment.]

.....Shall I see just one more?

> I can do the same as Lee Hyunsung
>
> —Upvotes 0 Downvotes 12
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 139)

I thought about what happened in chapter 139.

Chapter 139 is around episode 27.

It was probably when Nirvana came out, about when Jung Heewon was going on a rampage after being infected with Thought Infection. Was it the scene where Lee Hyunsung threw his whole body to stop Jung Heewon's runaway?

Dansoo ahjussi asked.

"That little girl is like us... right?"

"I think so."

I decided to contact her first.

However, as I approached, the girl started screaming.

"Uwaak! Help!"

"Excuse me."

"He's going to kill me, and even if he doesn't, he's going to do something bad anyway!"

I was about to say that there's no way I'd do such a thing, but then I remembered that I was Cheon Inho.

I held my hands up lightly, signaling that I meant no offense.

"No, I was just saying hello....."

As I was saying that, Bang Cheolsoo, who had popped up from the side, shouted.

"Listen up! From now on, our Cheoldoo Group will occupy Geumho Station! Drop everything you're carrying and head over there—"

I punched Bang Cheolsoo in the back of the head with all my might.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' has sponsored you 100 coins.]

After backing down Bang Cheolsoo, who looked back at me in frustration, I looked at the girl again.

"I'm not a bad person, you seem to misunderstand something."

"Don't come, you villain!"

"She's telling you not to come."

Jung Heewon's voice was determined as she hid the girl behind her.

The girl poked her head over Jung Heewon's shoulder and looked at me with a pleased face.

So that's how it is.

I sighed lightly and said.

"It can't be helped, so let's just talk like this."

Jung Heewon looked back and forth between me and the girl, then asked her.

"Is that okay?"

The girl looked at Jung Heewon in confusion, and Jung Heewon looked back at me.

"She's scared, you can talk to her another time."

"I have no intention of threatening her, and if I do, Jung Heewon-ssi can stop me."

I called for Bang Cheolsoo and was given a pipe. Just when Jung Heewon's expression hardened as if she thought I had finally shown my true colors, I handed the pipe to her.

"If you see me threatening her, hit me over the head with this."

"What?"

"Hard."

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries's eyes are shining.]

Jung Heewon stared down at the pipe she had been given, then said in a bewildered voice.

"I don't intend to go that far."

"Then let's get started."

I cleared my throat with a hmm, and began to speak in a theatrical voice.

"I like Jung Heewon."

"......?"

Jung Heewon looked at me with confused eyes.

I continued.

"From today on, I will do 100 push-ups, 100 squats, and run 10 kilometers every day to become

a man worthy of Heewon-nim."

Jung Heewon looked like she didn't know whether to slap me on the head or not.

"Heewon-nim... I love you... Seriously..."

"What are you doing?"

"I can do the same as Lee-"

"Now, wait!"

The contemplative girl eventually popped out from behind Jung Heewon.

I smirked and said.

"Are you ready to talk now? Judge Heewon—"

The girl who quickly covered my mouth looked back at Jung Heewon and smiled awkwardly.

"Unni. I'm sorry, I guess I got the wrong person."

"Are you okay? It sounds like you're being blackmailed?"

"No! I'm really not, so don't worry!"

Looking at the shaken girl, I was once again convinced.

This must be him.

This is the same person who sat next to me in the event theater.

Nickname [Judge Heewon].

The muscular man who answered the trivia question about the name of Jung Heewon's sword, roared, jumped on stage, and came to possess someone in this world.

Wait, I thought he was a man?

He, or she, who was now a tiny girl, even tinier than Jung Heewon, spoke over my mouth.

"Why don't we go over there and talk?"

---

"That..... Cheon Inho?"

"Yes."

"Who the hell are you?"

Judge Heewon looked at me and ahjussi with fear in her eyes, as if she were trying to figure out who we were by our looks. But there was no way she could have known who I was.

I realized that I needed to let her guard down a bit. Luckily, I had learned the social language to use in this situation.

"Jung Heewon is great."

"What? Of course....."

Judge Heewon's expression became strange.

"Wait, you-?"

"Yes."

"Your nickname is funny....."

I nodded.

"That all-carer? The one with the pretty girl?"

"That..... Yes."

"The one who couldn't get a single question right!"

"I got a question right, which is why I'm here."

Judge Heewon opened her mouth in a daze. She seemed to be organizing the situation in her head.

I added for reassurance.

"I'm in the same boat as you, and so is this ahjussi."

Dansoo ahjussi bowed slightly with a polite face.

Judge Heewon muttered in a trembling voice.

"I see, I'm not the only one....."

Judge Heewon looked at us with hollow eyes, as if she was going to burst into tears at any moment.

"I really thought I was going to die, but at least I remembered the first scenario."

"How did you clear it?"

"The usual, bugs are the law of the land."

Judging by the smugness in her voice, she had contributed to making a mess of the first scenario just like me.

"Actually, I almost died in the middle of the scenario when it was twisted up..... I got lucky. I was trapped with Heewon-nim."

She was trapped with Jung Heewon.....

As expected, it was thanks to Judge Heewon that Jung Heewon survived without killing anyone.

After taking a low breath, Judge Heewon said softly.

"Phew..... Anyway, if you're a reader too, you should have told me sooner. That was close."

"I've been trying to tell you all along, but you've been hiding and criticizing me."

"I didn't think someone would possess Cheon Inho. Why Cheon Inho?"

Why am I Cheon Inho?

I wonder that too.

In any case, Judge Heewon seemed to have completely lost her animosity.

"First of all, let's introduce each other. I'm Cheon Inho, as you can see."

"I'm Lee Dansoo."

Hearing our names, Judge Heewon nodded in understanding.

"It's the rule to speak by your given name, like in TRPG?"

I started to say, but stopped.

Judge Heewon said her new nickname with a shy face.

"I'm Kyung Sein."

"Can I call you Judge Heewon?"

"You should call me Kyung Sein."

She's an adaptable person.

---

It was still the first day of the scenario, and there was a lot of work to do.

Dansoo ahjussi had a poor memory, but Kyung Sein was a voracious reader who remembered quite a lot.

"After all, it's a national rule to collect food first at Geumho Station."

I wonder who set that rule.

It's like we all got together and made a 'How to Deal with the Apocalypse in Omniscient Reader'.

Anyway, we decided to split up and rob vending machines and mini convenience stores.

Bang Cheolsoo and the Cheoldoo Group joined us.

About thirty minutes passed.

"Is this it? Have you checked all the convenience stores nearby?"

"Yes, this is it."

We had succeeded in collecting all the food in Geumho Station.

There are currently 134 people trapped inside Geumho Station.

It was only enough food for one day.

Kyung Sein asked.

"What should we do? Should we sell them for coins?"

"No, we'll just give them away."

I could have sold them for coins and made a small profit, as Kim Dokja did. But I didn't choose that option.

Kyung Sein agreed.

"Well, I don't think it's right to accept coins from those people. Kim Dokja was definitely not normal."

"Sein-ssi, please distribute it to the people over there. Cheolsoo, you go to the other side."

"Alright."

"Dansoo ahjussi, you can share with me."

As we distributed the food, I looked at the faces of the citizens one by one.

I didn't realize it when I wrote this scene.

The looks on the faces of people who had just killed someone to survive.

"Thank you."

The dead in the first scenario all had their heads explode. The pale faces of the dead now rested on the faces of the living.

"As some of you may already know, there are monsters roaming outside right now, and it's wise to stay safe here and wait for rescue."

"Do you really think rescue will come?"

"They will come."

Of course, the rescuers wouldn't come.

[There are currently 48 people in Geumho Station who support you.]

[Currently 35% of Geumho Station supports you.]

Not bad. At this rate, I should be able to capture Geumho Station in the next 30 minutes and complete the scenario.

[The constellations of the 'absolute good' system are impressed by your dedication.]

[100 coins have been sponsored.]

In addition, I have gained the favor of the constellations.

The project to rehabilitate Cheon Inho was progressing steadily.

[The character 'Bang Cheolsoo' feels an unknown emotion.]

And maybe, Bang Cheolsoo.

"Cheolsoo hyung-nim. Are you doing well?"

"I don't know. Something's tickling me."

As they handed out the bread and snacks and they were thanked, the Cheoldoo Group looked somewhat reminiscent.

This is probably the first time they've ever heard anyone thank them.

I don't know how much of the story could have been changed by adding a few extra sentences to them.

But sometimes, even if you can't change anything, there's something you want to write. Like a question you can't help but ask even though you know the answer.

"Have you seen a girl named No Jiyoon?"

Dansoo ahjussi, who was helping distribute food next to me, would ask people the same question over and over again.

"I don't know, what does she look like?"

"That..... All I know is her name."

Jiyoon is the name of his daughter.

Actually, I'm sure Dansoo ahjussi knows it. Even if he asks people for his daughter's name here, he won't find her. His daughter is probably living under a different name, possessing a completely different person.

Still, he didn't stop asking.

As if the name alone was proof, in this strange and unfamiliar world, that he was not Lee Dansoo, but someone's father.

I stared at him for a moment, then opened my phone.

A platform app popped up on the screen.

Surely I had once been the author of Omniscient Reader. But could I still call myself the author of that novel?

All I have left to prove that time is this.

> Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint - 567 chapters
>
> —Author Lee Hakhyun

I stared blankly at the title of my novel.

I don't know how long I did that.

Suddenly, I got goosebumps on my spine.

What the hell?

I glared at the screen once more, specifically at the number of chapters.

Sure enough, the 'Omniscient Reader' I knew had been completed in chapter 551.

> Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint - 567 chapters

> —Author Lee Hakhyun

There were 15 more chapters.

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Author's Note

Thank you again today.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 569 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (6)

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I went through the newly expanded table of contents one by one. Even as I was looking, the table of contents grew by one.


Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (6) +[21]

Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (5) +[24]

.....

Episode 2. Rewrite (1) +[49]

Episode 1. The World After Completion (2) +[41]

Episode 1. The World After Completion (1) +[63]

Prologue. This is not an Announcement +[98]


A total of 568 chapters.

What the hell happened?

When I looked closely, there was also an event bonus.

When I thought about it, I remembered that I wrote such a side story for Yoo Joonghyuk's birthday event.

But did I post it in the series?

I wish I could see what it was about.

I hesitated for a moment, then decided to check the comments of the latest episode.

[1 free daily pass will be deducted.]

[One random comment from the chapter will be released at random.]

Free pass?

—First.

The only comment I could see was one in the middle of the ranking, and all the others were covered.

What's going on?

I went back and checked the comments on the older episodes.

Sure enough, I could see all the comments up to chapter 552.

The problem was the comments for the later episodes.

[You can read up to three free daily comments for chapters after 553.]

[You currently have 2 free daily passes.]

[If you run out of free passes, you can use coins to view the comments.]

[3,000 coins will be deducted for each comment.]

It was ridiculous.

3,000 coins for each additional comment?

No, 3,000 coins was my entire fortune now.

I decided to start with the free passes.

First, chapter 553.

[1 free daily pass will be deducted.]

| |
|---|
| —Oh? |

I felt a twinge of resentment.

I tapped on chapter 556.

[1 free daily pass will be deducted.]

[You have used up all of your free daily passes for today.]

| |
|---|
| —Wow, so it's a story where the author possesses Cheon Inho? |

Fortunately, this time it was a comment from which I could infer the context of the story.

After all, the content of the serialized excerpt was describing my current situation of possession.

My head was spinning.

Who is publishing this?

Is someone writing this story under my name instead of me?

If this is a novel, are my thoughts being described?

「If so, am I thinking, or am I being thought.」

I don't know.

There was nothing I could tell for certain right now.

"There."

Jung Heewon came to me during a break after the food distribution was over.

"Can I sit next to you for a while?"

"Oh, sure."

Jung Heewon sat down on the bench I was sitting on. However, she didn't speak to me right away.

I hadn't realized it before because I was too busy, but it felt strange to think that the character I wrote was sitting next to me.

This person is definitely not a type.

The white skin, long hair, and deep eyes looking at me are all real.

Jung Heewon was indeed present in front of me now.

"I'm sorry about earlier, Sein told me it was a misunderstanding. She said it was because you look so much like the person she hated....."

"No, it was a misunderstanding. It's fine."

It's not that I looked alike, I am the one she hated.

I pulled a canned drink out of my pocket and handed it over.

"Would you like some?"

"Oh, thanks."

We sat side by side and drank our canned drinks, both of us staring out at the empty tracks, and I remembered the text of Omniscient Reader.

Come to think of it, Kim Dokja also sat on the platform at Geumho Station with Jung Heewon.

She said.

"The train won't come anymore, will it?"

No matter how long we wait, the train won't come. Neither will the next train, nor the one after that.

But the lack of trains didn't mean anyone was going to die right away.

"I guess I'll just have to get used to walking."

Jung Heewon glanced at me and said.

"You're so calm, Inho-ssi. I can't do that."

"It's because I usually have strange imaginations."

Jung Heewon smiled bitterly at the words 'strange imaginations'.

"That's funny, Sein said something similar."

According to Jung Heewon, she and Kyung Sein were trapped in the same area in the first scenario.

I knew the gist of it.

She told me that, as she panicked, Kyung Sein caught a bug for her, and that's how they survived.

"Luckily, there must have been a lot of bugs."

"There was only one bug."

"What?"

Thinking about it, we were lucky to have vending machines in our area, but I'm sure not all areas had them.

Surely, there must have been areas with very few bugs.

"I'm the only one who survived with the bug."

"And Sein-ssi....."

"It was self-defense. He had nothing to say even if he died."

The expression on Jung Heewon's face as she said that, somehow reminded me of the 'Judge of Evil' from Omniscient Reader that I knew.

But she killed a man? It didn't look like it from the outside.

"By the way, Cheon Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"Do you happen to know me?"

"What?"

"And what you said earlier."

What did I say earlier?

"That..... No."

「Heewon-nim... I love you... Surely...」

Goosebumps suddenly rose on my forearms.

"Oh, that."

Thinking about it, it wasn't strange that Jung Heewon misunderstood me in that kind of situation.

"You should just forget about it."

"Shall we?"

"Yeah."

I thought I felt a strange gaze in the distance, but it was Kyung Sein who had stopped squatting and was staring at us.

Jung Heewon breathed a sigh of relief.

"Thank God. I was actually worried that you were a strange person."

"You don't have to worry about that."

I'm afraid of what Ji Eunyu will say if she finds out.

What kind of writer confesses to a character they created?

Jung Heewon scratched her cheek at my strong denial and smiled.

"Anyway, keep up the good work. I was a little surprised to see you handing out food to people earlier, I didn't expect that."

[Character 'Jung Heewon' has a faint sense of trust in you.]

Suddenly, I understood why Jung Heewon was talking to me.

[The majority of your region now thinks of you as a leader.]

[You have conquered 'Geumho Station'.]

[You will receive the sub scenario rewards.]

[500 coins have been earned.]

[If you survive to the fourth main scenario, you will receive additional benefits from completing the sub scenario.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says your ploy is really pretty good.]

Wow, all these rewards?

Cheon Inho didn't get to enjoy any of this and died right away in the main story.

I have to be really nice to Kim Dokja when I meet him.

Yes, Kim Dokja.

It was time to go meet the real Kim Dokja.

---

"Is everyone ready to go?"

"Yes."

"Not yet, wait a bit."

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi each held a pipe with a cloth tied around the handle. These were our temporary weapons for the time being.

"But are you going to leave the Cheoldoo Group here? I thought you made a group to lead the way in times like this."

She wasn't wrong.

However, if we were accompanied by the Cheoldoo Group unnecessarily and ran into Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk, we might get into trouble.

Kyung Sein nodded in understanding.

"I see. It would be easy to misunderstand, but if you put it that way, Cheon Inho's existence is a problem."

"We'll find an excuse somehow."

"What are you going to say?"

"Sein-ssi should say it, not me. Do you think Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk would listen to me?"

"Oh, yeah. Uh..... what should I say? I'm not good at talking. So where would they be by now?"

"They're probably just finishing up the 'Even Bridge' scenario."

In the main part of Omniscient Reader, Kim Dokja and the others are separated by the breaking of the Dongho Bridge.

"Since Kim Dokja would have been eaten by the ichthyosaur straight away, we're likely to meet Yoo Joonghyuk, Lee Hyunsung, Yoo Sangah, Lee Gilyoung..... the other members first."

That's what would be common sense.

Of course, that's assuming the scenario plays out in the same way as in the original.

"We'll probably meet Han Myungoh, too."

It was Dansoo ahjussi who said that.

It seemed that he was finally ready to leave, too, and something was floating over his head. He must have gotten some sort of privilege from his constellation.

Thank goodness, at least it wasn't a very bad constellation.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' expects great things from incarnation 'Lee Dansoo'.]

"So the three of us are going like this? Will that be okay?"

Dansoo ahjussi had a strangely worried face.

Actually, I was worried too.

Right now, we only had a man with a naturally muscular body and a girl with the soul of a muscular man.

"Do you have any combat skills? Like [Weapon Training]?"

In response to my question, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi shook their heads at the same time.

We didn't even have the basics.

But Kyung Sein was confident.

"Still, don't you think we can handle a few ground rats? We've got some experience."

I agreed with that, too.

This is who we are.

It was a party consisting of the author of Omniscient Reader (though Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi didn't know yet) and two completionists.

After all, it's a story where the author, reader, and protagonist work together to reach the ending, so there's nothing we can't do.

"By the way, can we just talk about the novel like this? The constellations—"

"It'll be fine. Even in Omniscient Reader, all the stuff about Ways of Survival is filtered out at the beginning."

"But there's no guarantee that'll be the case here—"

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' grumbles, wondering what the hell you are talking about.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' complains that the conversation was filtered incorrectly.]

Kyung Sein shook her head in admiration.

"Wow, it's true. As expected of Omniscient Reader."

Was that an insult or a compliment?

I didn't bother to ask.

We stepped into the tunnel that led straight to Oksu Station.

As the darkness of the claustrophobic tunnel enveloped us, I was suddenly aware of my heavy breathing.

One step, two steps.

A chill seeped into my ankles with each step. The sensation of being in real danger was palpable.

All three of us seemed to be thinking the same thing, but none of us spoke up.

Finally, it was Kyung Sein, who had the soul of a muscular man, who spoke first.

"Should we just go back? I mean, we can wait at Geumho Station and still meet them, so why go out of our way?"

"It's better if we pick them up. You know, in case something happens."

"Sure..... the first scenario has changed."

"Let's go, and if it looks like we're in danger, we'll run."

Of course, I had no intention of running away. For my own safety, it was best to make contact with the main characters at this timing.

The worst that could happen was that Kim Dokja and the others were dead.

But even if they were all dead, there would still be one person alive.

Yoo Joonghyuk, the true protagonist of Ways of Survival and the strongest incarnation in Omniscient Reader.

If things were really going to go south, someone would have to confront him on Kim Dokja's behalf. Someone had to convince him, cajole him, and somehow see the end of this damned scenario.

「But which one of us is up to the task?」

I was lost in thought for a second. As I returned to my thoughts, I could hear Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi talking. They were squatting together and had apparently become quite close.

"Did you sign a sponsor contract too?"

"Yes."

"Who did you sign with?"

"Sneaky Schemer."

"Sneaky Schemer?"

I had told him to stop talking, but he couldn't help himself and bragged about it.

For the record, Dansoo ahjussi still confuses 'Sneaky Schemer' with 'Secretive Plotter', the most powerful man in Omniscient Reader.

And just now,

"It's not that constellation?"

He finally realized that it wasn't the right constellation.

"Did you just skim the novel?"

Ahjussi asked in a voice full of disbelief, and Kyung Sein frowned.

"What are you talking about? I've read it thoroughly. I've also read the 'Encyclopedia of Omniscient Reader' compiled by 'RepresentativeKimDokja' at least ten times. How many times have you seen it?"

"What's that?"

"Forget it, the constellation you're talking about is 'Secretive Plotter', not 'Sneaky Schemer'. How could you get that mixed up?"

"No way....."

"I-I'm sure Jiyoon said this constellation is the best..."

"Because of Jiyoon or whatever, you're totally screwed. They look like a weird constellation."

"Jiyoon is my daughter."

As I watched the conversation with interest, I suddenly realized that I hadn't heard any messages from the 'Sneaky Schemer'.

If someone talked about you openly like this, wouldn't you interrupt? Had he left the channel?

Suddenly, I became nervous. If we had made Bihyung's channel less popular, the planned stream contract talks could fall through.

'Bihyung. Are you there?'

Even when I tried talking to him, he didn't reply.

Did we lose communication?

[A few constellations are talking about who is 'Sneaky Schemer'.]

I realized that the channel wasn't dead, as there was still a response from the constellations.

I could think about it later, now was the time to move.

"Let's speed up a little bit."

"Okay."

"Let's do it."

One minute later

"We're slowing down."

"Inho-ssi should lead the way. You're the leader."

This was not a powerful party consisting of an author and two completionists; it was just a party of wimps.

At this rate, we could walk all day to Oksu Station and still not make it.

"Hey, guys."

Unexpectedly, it was Dansoo ahjussi who came to the rescue, looking like he was thinking about something.

"If you don't mind, I'd like to do a little scouting on my own."

"What? You're going to get yourself killed, ahjussi. Your sponsor isn't Secretive Plotter."

"I know. My sponsor is Sneaky Schemer."

For some reason, at that moment, Dansoo ahjussi looked like a dashing Kim Dokja once again.

"So there's something I can do."

Ahjussi stared at the floor and muttered something under his breath.

A moment later, dozens of cockroaches swarmed across the floor.

"U-uaak!"

Kyung Sein clung onto me. I took a step back to avoid her.

The cockroaches that had gathered near ahjussi moved their antennae as if to communicate with him, and then they began to move in a single file line toward Oksu Station.

Kyung Sein shook her hand and asked.

"Ahjussi. Isn't that [Diverse Communication]? How did you learn that skill? Is your attribute [Insect Collector]?"

If I recall correctly, there were only a few main characters in the original novel who had that skill.

He wiped the sweat from his forehead and said.

"I got it from the constellation."

From the constellation?

His sponsor gave him a skill like that?

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' re-enters the channel.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is surprised to see how far you've come.]

For the briefest of moments, a thought flashed through my mind.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' smiles happily at the cockroaches.]

No way.....

It's not that, right?

---

Author's Note

Sing: The first boarding house I chose in college was very old, and there were a lot of cockroaches. My older brother, who lived on the first floor, loved to tear off the legs of cockroaches. From then on, I became afraid of people who were good at catching cockroaches.

Shong: However, Sing sometimes spoke with respect to their brother.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 570 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (7)

"They say there's nothing ahead."

Thanks to the cockroaches' forewarning of danger, we were able to move at a faster pace than before.

Kyung Sein said admiringly.

"The cockroaches are so OP."

"What's OP?"

"That..... It's too good, so maybe your sponsor is more useful than I thought?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' grumbles asking 'Did you realize that just now?']

Things certainly weren't bad.

At this point, Dansoo ahjussi could easily play the role of Lee Gilyoung in the main story.

We walked for about ten minutes.

He stopped for the first time.

"There's something up ahead."

We gasped in unison.

A few cockroaches scurried toward him, their antennae twitching violently.

"I think it's one ground rat."

I didn't think there were ground rats in this section.

I thought for a moment and said.

"Let's wait. Maybe it's one that got separated from the mischief and was wandering around."

I didn't want to risk an encounter. We waited, hiding ourselves.

1 minute, 5 minutes, 10 minutes.

The ground rat showed no sign of going away.

Dansoo ahjussi looked a little tired, as if he'd used [Diverse Communication] too many times in such a short period of time.

"What shall we do?"

Oksu Station was just around the corner. It would be a shame to turn back here.

"Let's catch it, it's only one."

Kyung Sein suggested first.

"We have to fight at some point, and we can't go through the scenario without catching one. It's a monster that Yoo Sangah and Lee Gilyoung also caught, so let's not be scared."

Turns out she was right.

Lightly stretching her shoulders and neck, Kyung Sein continued.

"If you have any useful skills, show them all instead of hiding them. For reference, I have [Average Correction]."

As expected, I thought that if she was a complete reader, she would have at least one hidden hand.

By the way, [Average Correction].

It's a skill that wasn't detailed in Omniscient Reader, but I remembered setting it up.

"It's a little tricky to explain, but if you raise one of your stats, the rest of your stats will be corrected to 70% of your highest stats. For example, if you raise your physique level to 10, you'll have a performance level of 7 without leveling up strength or agility."

"Huh, that's a pretty cool skill."

It was definitely a powerful skill. It meant that from now on, Kyung Sein could go all-in on just one main stat.

In the early stages, when coins are hard to come by for stats, there's no better skill.

"I only have the [Diverse Communication] I showed you earlier..... What about my mate?"

I checked my skills one by one.

[■■]

[Character List]

[Incite]

These were the only three skills I knew.

Sometimes I hear a character's inner thoughts, so I think there's a skill that's similar to [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], but I haven't figured out how to activate it yet.

"Unfortunately, my skills are all related to inciting through speech. As you can see, it's Cheon Inho."

"Phew, it can't be helped, but it's not a bad situation. There are three of us and only one of it, so on the signal of one, two, three, we'll all run and beat it up."

"Let's be careful not to get hurt."

We looked at each other and cautiously approached the ground rat.

We must have taken thirty steps.

The shadow of a monster emerged from the darkness.

「The size of a fully-grown wolf. A mole-like creature with developed forepaws.」

There was no mistaking it.

It was a 9th grade underground species, the ground rat.

But..... Was it that big?

"Uh, wait a minute."

Kyung Sein also stopped walking as if she noticed something strange.

Kooooo.

An ominous howl.

A pair of yellow eyes glowed in the darkness, and a boar-like creature charged toward us. The ground rumbled lightly, and stones bounced off the bottom of the track.

The frail Kim Dokja had actually caught a monster like this?

"Hiyoooop!"

Dansoo ahjussi let out a strange shout and swung his pipe in an excited gesture.

But his weak pipe grazed the ground rat's face and bounced off.

"Ahjussi!"

Dansoo ahjussi barely rolled out of the way of the collision.

I was next.

Come.

Despite this, my strength level is 10. There's no way I can't catch a monster that even a kid like Lee Gilyoung could catch.

I swung the pipe with all my might, but it missed. The moment the blow hit, the ground rat quickly lowered its head.

Oops.

I spun around and landed on my butt.

When I quickly raised my head, the ground rat was running past me toward its target. It had instinctively chosen the weakest-looking prey among us.

"Sein-ssi!"

The terrified Kyung Sein held up her pipe, her arms shaking.

"Uh, Uwaaaak!"

Throwing the pipe, Kyung Sein turned around and started running.

"What are you doing! Catch it!"

"H-How can I catch something like that!"

How different fiction was from reality.

Is that really the same beast that Yoo Sangah and Lee Gilyoung fought?

Kyung Sein, who was running fast, tripped over the tracks and fell. The ground rat didn't miss the opportunity, howling as it pounced on her.

With a thud, she bounced off and hit the wall of the train tracks.

I thought she was dead, but to my surprise, Kyung Sein staggered to her feet.

"Uaaaa! It hurts! It hurts!"

The reason was obvious.

Kyung Sein had gone all-in on her physique.

Just as I had invested my coins in strength, she had invested all of her coins in physique.

"Don't run, pick up your weapon! Over here! You bastard!"

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.2' is activated.]

I activated [Incite] half-heartedly, and it turned to look in my direction. It didn't seem to understand me, but at least I'd turned off its aggression.

With Kyung Sein haphazardly picking up her weapon, Dansoo ahjussi and I formed a chaotic formation.

Luckily, the ground rat only let out a snarl and didn't try to charge again.

"You said you were going to be a man worthy of Heewon-ssi."

"Heewon-nim is strong, I can help her as a wife!"

"You've killed people, you can't just run away like that."

I wish I hadn't said that.

Pale and fed up, Kyung Sein asked.

"I killed a man? Who told you that?"

"Heewon-ssi."

"I..... I just closed my eyes and finished the kid Heewon-nim left half dead."

As I watched Kyung Sein's shaking hand holding the pipe, it all made sense.

That was why Jung Heewon had such a strong expression on her face.

"If you really don't want to die, make up your mind."

The plan was a complete failure.

There was no way an ordinary reader in real life could possess someone in a novel and suddenly start acting like Kim Dokja.

「I wonder how many of them survived.」

Just as the sudden anxiety was taking over my mind, Dansoo ahjussi called out to me in a trembling voice.

"I-Inho-ssi."

The ground rat that had been confronting us had four eyes now.

Damn.

He'd called for his colleague.

"Turn around."

We started running toward Geumho Station. But the chasing ground rats were faster.

"Ahjussi! Hurry!"

Dansoo ahjussi, who had relatively low physique and strength, lagged behind. I slowed down a bit to keep pace with him.

That's when I heard a squeak. I looked to the side and saw a ground rat nibbling at the hem of my clothes.

The smell of blood hit my nose.

I couldn't believe I was going to die like this, not from a monster, but from a ground rat. At the same time, I realized that I wanted to write a novel about this story.

「The Ultimate Omniscient Reader Party. Wiped out by a 9th grade underground species, the ground rat.」

But who would read such a novel?

I let out a shout and smashed the ground rat's head with my pipe. But its grip was stronger than I thought.

"Ahjussi! Run! Come on!"

I can't take on both of them with all my might now. It's even more impossible for me alone.

At least I can buy some time.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.2' is strongly activated!]

My skill once again drew the attention of the ground rats.

I gripped the pipe with both hands like a baseball bat and slammed it into the side of one of them. It squirmed in pain and fell from me.

The problem was the other one.

In an ominous flash of foreboding, a large shadow leaped up behind me. It was too late to react.

"Get out of the way!"

With a sharp voice, a pipe flew out of nowhere and pierced the ground rat's eye.

Kuaaaak!

The sharpened end of the pipe went straight through the ground rat's skull and out the other side.

The pipe was pulled straight out and left an efficient trajectory toward the second ground rat.

I knew the identity of that trace.

A skill that was dismissed as insignificant in Omniscient Reader.

[Kendo(劍道)]

However, there were some characters who practiced it to the limit and finally slit the throats of demons.

The flowing trace of the pipe sliced through the head of the staggering second ground rat.

As it collapsed, the red glow extinguished from its eyes as it looked at me.

"I knew this would happen."

Last time, I thought I couldn't help it even if Ji Eunyu teased me. This time, I thought I might actually fall in love with her.

"Are you okay?"

It was Jung Heewon.

---

"Sniff sniff, Heewon unni, I mean, it was so hard for us."

Kyung Sein held on to Jung Heewon and sobbed. "I thought I was really going to die! Why did you only come now?"

"Thanks to you, I'm alive. I didn't know they were so strong....."

Dansoo ahjussi also thanked her, exhausted.

I did the same.

"You saved my life, you really put up a good fight."

"Are your wounds okay?"

"Yes. It's nothing, thankfully."

Luckily, the ground rat's teeth had only scratched my side.

Still, if Jung Heewon hadn't come, I would have died there.

I completely miscalculated our power. I didn't expect the readers party to be so crappy.

"I came here because I was worried. I saw two weak men and a small girl leaving as a scouting party... I was honestly nervous."

Apparently, Jung Heewon was the only one who objectively grasped our party's strength.

However, the previous battle was surprising even when I thought about it again.

Jung Heewon was this strong.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Jung Heewon

Age: 27 years old

Sponsor: None (Two constellations are currently showing interest in this person.)

Exclusive Attributes: Crouching Figure (Common)

Exclusive Skills: [Demon Slaying Lv.1], [Kendo Lv.1]

Stigma: None

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.5], [Strength Lv.6], [Agility Lv.7], [Magic Power Lv.4]

Overall Evaluation: She's a 'Crouching Figure' with enormous potential. The attribute information isn't verified yet because the attribute hadn't blossomed. She currently has a faint faith in you.

I can't believe that 'Cheon Inho' is trusted by Jung Heewon.

Life really is hard to understand.

"But why did you move in such a hurry?"

Jung Heewon's question made Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi look at me at the same time.

"Because we have to rescue the survivors."

"Survivors?"

"There's someone I know near Oksu Station."

Jung Heewon nodded as if she understood.

"I see. Your parents, your family?"

"If I had to say..... They're like family."

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi looked at me and nodded.

Jung Heewon said.

"If that's the case, I'll help you too."

"I'd really appreciate it."

I thought it would be okay to go with Jung Heewon. She was going to be a main member of Kim Dokja's Company, so there was no harm if she accompanied us in advance.

However, there was something I needed to do before I left again.

I looked down at the bodies of the two fallen ground rats.

"Hmm? What are you going to do?"

There were two main reasons why our party was so unsuccessful.

One, the lack of main combat skills, and two.

"Let's make weapons."

As if something had come to their mind, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi jumped out of their seats.

It must have been the development of the main story.

However, Kyung Sein's expression brightened for a moment, and then quickly darkened.

"But..... Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"Do you know how to do it?"

That was the problem.

---

"Ground rat's spine sword! Ground rat's spine sword!"

Kyung Sein had been repeating the words like a mantra for several minutes now, holding the head of a ground rat.

Dansoo ahjussi asked.

"What are you doing?"

"I'm trying to do something."

I think she has watched too many cartoons.

I left Kyung Sein alone and took out the knife I had borrowed from the Cheoldoo Group earlier.

Then I used Incite on myself.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv2' is activated!]

「This isn't gross at all. I'm a professional butcher.」

I grabbed the ground rat by the head and started tearing off its skin. Honestly, I was worried because I've never done any butchering before, but it wasn't as hard as I thought.

Upon closer inspection, I realized that the skin had a dotted line along the spine. Like a creature made to be cut along the dotted line.

I thought that this was enough for people who hadn't read 'Ways of Survival' like Kim Dokja, then I turned to the side and saw Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi gagging.

Oh well, that's normal.

Jung Heewon, on the other hand, stuck to my side and watched the whole grooming process with interest.

"Where did you learn to do this?"

"Self-taught."

"Wow....."

My shoulders got tense for no reason.

I must be pretty talented, right? Jung Heewon added with a wry smile.

"But since you're self-taught, you're not very good at it."

"Don't bully me."

I grunted for about twenty minutes.

With a snap, the first ground rat's spine was cleanly separated.

Dansoo ahjussi was impressed.

"Now that's a convincing one."

Even in their natural state, the vertebrae of ground rats resembled a sword. Indeed, a creature that defied evolutionary odds to have a spine made by a single bone.

"This is for Heewon-ssi."

"Really? Can I take it?"

"Because you're our team's biggest power."

Jung Heewon was a monster who could beat two ground rats with a pipe, and then I gave her a ground rat knife?

It's only a matter of catching the bus from now on.

"Ah..... Thank you."

Jung Heewon accepted the knife as if she was embarrassed, and then examined the front and back of the knife for a long time.

"Suddenly I feel like I'm back in the Paleolithic age."

I stopped and looked up. I thought it sounded familiar, but then I realized it was a line from Omniscient Reader.

I hesitated for a moment.

「May I answer?」

I inhaled lightly, then spoke in a somewhat theatrical tone.

"The bone is hard, so you need to grind it on a whetstone for it to be useful. There are rocks lying around here, so sharpen the blade skillfully."

"Heh, yes, Captain."

Originally, this conversation had been between Kim Dokja and Jung Heewon.

Kyung Sein, who came up behind them, scolded me with a whisper.

"Don't you think you're getting too close to Heewon-nim?"

"Well, someone has to look out for her. Until we meet Kim Dokja."

As I said that, my heart gradually grew heavy.

I wondered if I could do as much as Kim Dokja did.

Would I be able to help Jung Heewon survive in this world?

"By the way, there's a problem. Heewon-nim won't be able to grow as fast as things are going now."

As if reading my mind, Kyung Sein whispered.

"You remember that? Heewon-nim gets stronger for real after her awakening as the 'Judge of Destruction'. At this rate, even if we meet the real Kim Dokja, Heewon-nim

may not be as active as she was in the main novel."

That's right.

Jung Heewon's strongest skill is [Hour of Judgement].

In order to obtain it, she must become the 'Judge of Destruction'.

However, there are two prerequisites for her to do so.

One is that she is subjected to brutal violence by the Cheoldoo Group.

And two.

"In order for Heewon-nim to awaken as in the original, Cheon Inho-ssi must die."

My death.

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Author's Note

There's 2 chapters today.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 571 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (8)

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After obtaining the ground rat knife, our progress accelerated.

A few times along the way, we encountered small mischiefs of ground rats, but thanks to Jung Hee-won's skill, they were easily defeated.

It wasn't long before the group was able to get their hands on one each.

I wonder how long we walked.

Finally, the scenery of Oksu Station appeared.

"Wow, really. Wow."

After walking for only 20 minutes, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi's faces were covered in sweat.

Oksu Station is an aboveground station.

Looking at the faint sunlight, I suddenly had a thought.

「I don't want to die.」

I don't know why I felt that way.

What I do know is that one day I will write this sentence.

"I'll take a look around first. You can stay here for a while."

Jung Heewon jumped forward and stepped onto the platform with light steps.

Behind me, Kyung Sein asked.

"But is it okay for us to stay here? Oksu Station is above ground."

According to Omniscient Reader, the ground is covered in a 'poisonous fog' from the second main scenario onward.

"It's okay, I don't think there are any poisonous rhinoceros around here."

The poisonous fog was the fart of the 7th grade monster species, the great poisonous rhinoceros.

In other words, as long as there were no poisonous rhinoceros nearby, there was no danger of being exposed to the poisonous fog.

Kyung Sein shook her head in admiration.

"I can't believe you remembered something like that. May I ask how many times you've read it?"

"I've read it quite a lot."

I couldn't help it. Counting rewrites and revisions, I'd read it at least a dozen times per chapter. I read some sections over a hundred times.

"You're not famous, are you? You're not one of the Seven Apostles, are you?"

"What's that?"

"It's a group created by some of the most famous people in the world of Omniscient Reader—"

For a moment, I was confused if this was fiction or reality, because there is a similar group in Omniscient Reader.

"They say the world is big and there are many reclusive masters..... I guess my luck isn't so bad after meeting Inho-ssi."

"Can I hear that story you just told in detail?"

"What story, the Seven Apostles?"

"Yes."

"Well, it's not a big deal, it's just a bunch of fans who got together and named it as a joke —"

Kyung Sein began to ramble on about the 'Seven Apostles' in a somewhat excited voice.

I was shocked that a failed novel had such a club, but I was also surprised that it had been active for four years.

Since this is Omniscient Reader's world, it's likely that readers with a high number of completions had survived.

If we can bring them to our side, it will be a great help.

"I was there when it happened."

As Kyung Sein was recounting the three-days and three-nights setup battle between the 'Seven Apostles' and the 'Misreading Association', Jung Heewon returned from scanning Oksu Station.

"There are no survivors, I think they've all gone to the surface."

"Thank you for your hard work."

"What should we do? Your family—"

Seeing Jung Heewon worrying about others even in the midst of this, I realized that she doesn't have to be the Judge of Destruction.

Is it necessary for her to go through that pain again only for her awakening?

There are many ways to become stronger. I can't say that the development of the main story is the only answer.

"They must be nearby, maybe coming from that direction."

I said, looking to the other side of the tracks leading to the Dongho Bridge.

I could finally meet the main characters of Omniscient Reader.

I could meet Kim Dokja, Yoo Joonghyuk, Lee Hyunsung, Yoo Sangah and Lee Gilyoung.

I exchanged glances with Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi and walked along the tracks.

In the distance, I could see the tracks leading to Dongho Bridge. The bridge was already broken in the middle, as if the ichthyosaur had made a mess and disappeared.

We paused, stared, and waited.

The fishy smell of the Han River wafted through the air.

It was time for the people to come running.

It was time for Lee Hyunsung, Yoo Sangah, Lee Gilyoung, and Han Myungoh, who had crossed the Even Bridge created by 「Deus Ex Machina」 over the Dongho Bridge, to appear.

"That's weird, I don't see anyone—"

The moment Kyung Sein said that.

「Time stopped.」

I panicked as I watched the world around me turn colorless in an instant.

If time had stopped now, there was only one reason.

The skill [■■] had been triggered.

But why?

I didn't see anyone around me who would suddenly do something unexpected?

[Someone wants to do something unexpected.]

Huh?

The letters swirled around me, and a snowy landscape appeared.

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '■■' have been partially met.]

[The exclusive skill '■■' has been activated.]

What do you mean 'someone'?

[You have an absurdly low understanding of that character.]

[You can't intervene in the character's actions.]

And a character I can't intervene with? Where?

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

I hadn't written anything, and the message was one-sided.

I decided to check the feedback first.

> rlaehrwk37: Suddenly everyone's going to die here?

I felt my heart sink.

Everyone's going to die?

Here? Suddenly?

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.....]

I instinctively felt a sense of crisis. It was a writer's intuition.

I don't know what happened, but if 'Snowfield' ends here, my party and I will be wiped out. I had this premonition.

'Wait, wait a moment!'

At my shout, the disappearing snowy landscape returned.

[You want to do something unexpected.]

This skill is triggered when someone wants to do something 'unexpected'.

[Describe your own behavior.]

[You have spent 5 probability points.]

And that, I can do.

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '■■' have been met again.]

[The exclusive skill '■■' has been reactivated.]

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

[Describe the next action of 'Cheon Inho'.]

And a window appeared in front of my eyes.

> # Cheon Inho's Station
>
> ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■.....」
>
> * At your current skill level, you can write a total of 160 additional characters.

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield' for a total of 3 minutes.]

I quickly wrote down something along the lines of, 'Cheon Inho reacted quickly to the crisis and saved the party members.'

[This story's content is vague.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 10%.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

> rlaehrwk37 : What is it with Cheon Inho
>
> rlaehrwk81 : You don't even know what's going on

No, what the hell was going on.

I decided to stay calm and take a look at my surroundings. First of all, the place I was in, the background, and the people.....

Then something caught my eye.

「Cracks were spreading upward through the tunnel.」

[You found a background clue.]

[You can reserve additional probability in your description.]

Now I had a glimpse of what was about to happen.

I quickly typed a sentence.

「At that moment, Cheon Inho noticed the collapsing ceiling. He reflexively pulled Jung Heewon, who was walking ahead of him, and shouted to the two remaining people. "Everyone, stick to the wall!" Moments later, the tunnel ceiling collapsed. In a cloud of dust, Cheon Inho confirmed the fate of his colleagues. Fortunately, no one was injured.」

[This story is lacking probability.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 43%.]

This time, the odds have gone up quite a bit.

[Do you want to try to recreate it?]

[If you fail, your group will be wiped out.]

43% chance was too vague.

I pondered.

This description is lacking probability.....

After much deliberation, I changed some of the sentences while keeping the basic framework intact.

「At the risk of tearing the ligaments in his right arm, Cheon Inho pushed his companions back with all his strength.」

[This story is lacking probability.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 67%.]

The success rate has increased.

This approach is not wrong.

I made one more edit.

「At the risk of tearing the ligaments in both his arms, Cheon Inho pushed his companions back with all his strength.」

[This story is very plausible.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 98%.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk37: Strong<br><br>rlaehrwk81: They're alive, but they're still screwed |

Is this the only way?

It took a while for Kim Dokja 81 to talk, but there was no other way now.

[Successfully recreating the scene.]

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

At the same time as the message, both of my arms swelled up greatly. I could feel my level 10 strength expanding beyond their limits.

I immediately grabbed Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi by the waist, threw them backwards with all my might, and rolled around holding Jung Heewon.

Kwaaaaaang!

There was a loud explosion, and a terrible pain shot through both my arms.

The ceiling immediately collapsed in a cloud of white dust. Heavy debris brushed past my cheeks and arms.

When I managed to come to my senses with a few coughs, I heard a faint moan in my arms.

Jung Heewon was safe.

Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein had been knocked a good distance away, but they didn't seem to be too seriously injured.

「I'm alive.」

My whole body shook. My left arm didn't move as if its ligaments were broken, and my right arm could barely move, but was nearly paralyzed.

Nevertheless, it wasn't over yet.

An intermittent tremor in the ground told me that whatever had caused this collapse was approaching us.

Kukukukuku.

Moments later, a large, dark shadow loomed above the broken tunnel.

It was a monster I recognized.

7th grade monster species, the great poisonous rhinoceros.

I had a terrible feeling. This is why the feedback said that.

Even if I survive here, I'm doomed to be killed by that beast.

As the violet eyes of the one-horned rhinoceros stared at me, its massive forefoot lifted into the air.

I'll be trampled.

I tried to move, but my body wouldn't budge.

"Heewon-ssi! Wake up! Quickly!"

A black shadow covered my eyes.

This time, it was the end.

And then.

「A pale trajectory sliced through the air.」

Jung Heewon's swordsmanship was amazing, but that beautiful, ecstatic trajectory was incomparable.

The severed forefoot of the poisonous rhinoceros landed beside me, bleeding unrealistically.

I watched the whole thing, covered in the beast's blood.

Then a second trajectory bloomed.

「No way.」

The image of the poisonous rhinoceros's horn, ears, and legs being cut off one after another.

The terrifying 7th grade monster, screaming in agony, collapsed.

「At this point, there shouldn't be any incarnation that can deal with that beast.」

A slow chill ran down my spine as I looked at the black-coated back of the man holding a long spear.

「There is. One person.」

A man in a black coat stood over the corpse of the poisonous rhinoceros that had fallen with a roar.

Just making eye contact sent a shiver down my spine.

I didn't need anyone to tell me.

The man who carried all the world's tragedies on his back.

The hero of 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World', the book Kim Dokja read for a decade.

"Why are you here?"

Yoo Joonghyuk.

Author's Note

Long time no see

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 572 Episode 3. Protagonist(?) (9)

---

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is warning you.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is glaring at 'Yoo Joonghyuk' with cold eyes.]

An alarm bell rang in my head.

I'm meeting Yoo Joonghyuk first?

What about Lee Hyunsung? Yoo Sangah? Lee Gilyoung and Han Myungoh?

No, do they 'all' really exist?

The moment I met Yoo Joonghyuk's piercing eyes, an eerie sensation washed over me.

「The original Cheon Inho didn't meet Yoo Joonghyuk now.」

I managed to keep my composure.

A quick glance behind me revealed that Jung Heewon, Kyung Sein, and Dansoo ahjussi hadn't woken up yet.

I have no choice but to try to talk my way out of this.

Luckily, there were many approaches that could be used if the opponent was Yoo Joonghyuk.

In the early stages, Yoo Joonghyuk is a bit simple-minded, so I might be able to get out of the situation by claiming to be a prophet like Kim Dokja.

"Answer me, why are you hanging around in this place?"

However, the moment I heard those words, I felt something strange.

First, I noticed the weapon in his hand.

A spear that looked like it was carved from the bones of a monster species.

Suddenly, I felt goosebumps.

「3rd round Yoo Joonghyuk doesn't use a spear.」

Without hesitation, I activated 'Character List'.

['Character List' is activating!]

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

[There is too much information about this person. 'Character List' is converted to 'Character Summary'.]

Along with a slight dizziness, Yoo Joonghyuk's information flashed before my eyes.

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Yoo Joonghyuk

.....(Omitted).....

Exclusive Skills: [Sage's Eye Lv.9], [Hand to Hand Combat Lv.10], [Weapons Training Lv.10], [Mental Barrier Lv.6], [Crowd Control Lv.7], [Reasoning Lv.7], [Lie Detection Lv.7].....

An endless list of skills.

However, that's not what surprised me.

The moment I saw Yoo Joonghyuk's 'attributes' and 'Regressor' on the list, my mind went blank.

「How the hell could this happen?」

There was only one thought in my head.

「If I stay here, I'll die.」

And then.

"You must have met Anna Croft in the Chungmuro Tunnel. You recalled the memories of the last round....."

I stared at Yoo Joonghyuk, dumbfounded.

What was he talking about?

"Cheon Inho, why are you here? If you remembered, you would have remembered the promise we made."

Suddenly, my head was spinning.

What the hell is this guy talking about?

When I didn't answer, Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardened slightly.

"Why did you come looking for me? Are you unhappy with our promise now?"

It was a major crisis.

There was no mention of this development anywhere in Omniscient Reader. The same was true for 'Ways of Survival'.

[You want to do something unexpected.]

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '□□' have been met.]

If you can, you should experiment with all your options. Moreover, if your opponent is 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.

[Your creativity is currently depleted and you can't enter the 'Snowfield'.]

[You can take a penalty and enter the 'Snowfield' once more.]

[If you make an additional entry, you will no longer be able to enter today.]

[Do you want to enter the 'Snowfield'?]

For a moment, I was worried.

Is this the last entry of the day?

「I'm not entering.」

In the end, I canceled the skill.

There could be a bigger crisis than this, I couldn't risk it hastily.

I had to trust my high level eloquence for now.

I took a deep breath and began my story.

"Do you think I came here for that appointment?"

I could feel him pause for a moment. Whether he did or not, I acted shamelessly.

"I was just looking around to see if there were any items to pick up nearby. How naive of you to think I'd come to see you first."

As I said this, I rummaged through the body of the dead poisonous rhinoceros.

The poisonous rhinoceros was a 7th grade monster.

If I could get a piece of its body now, it would be very useful in the early stages.

"You....."

I turned my head at the sound of the voice and saw Yoo Joonghyuk looking down at me with disdain.

But why? Contempt is definitely contempt.

"No matter how many rounds I do, your trashy behavior doesn't change."

He was smiling strangely.

I felt my hopes rise a little.

"I'm flattered."

As I began to cut off the tiny horn of the poisonous rhinoceros, Yoo Joonghyuk protested.

"That's mine."

"You can keep the tiny horn."

"Have you always been greedy for things like this?"

I felt hurt for a moment, but the water was already spilled anyway.

"I'm not as strong from the beginning as someone."

Yoo Joonghyuk gave me a strange look.

"This round is really weird. That happened in the first scenario too....."

"What happened?"

"None of your business."

"What happened to Lee Hyunsung and Kim Namwoon? Why didn't they come with you?"

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes turned cold at my questions.

"Don't think too much of yourself, Cheon Inho, do you really think we're colleagues or something? I'm sure you didn't forget what happened last round."

I'm confused.

We made a promise, and now he says we're not colleagues.

What is our relationship then?

"Don't forget what you're supposed to do. Don't make me regret hiring a scumbag like you."

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me with a scary look, and I couldn't help but widen my eyes.

Even narrow eyes can open wide.

"Thanks for the rant."

"You're even more loudmouthed than last round. Stop procrastinating and go back. You have work to do."

With those words, Yoo Joonghyuk gathered up several key parts of the 'poisonous rhinoceros' and turned back toward the tunnel.

"Don't come looking for me until you've sorted out what I ordered you to do. Next time you wander around, I'll kill you."

I watched Yoo Joonghyuk walk away, step by step, and somehow it didn't feel real.

「I survived.」

Relief washed over me.

I don't know why, but I survived. I had succeeded in fooling that 'Yoo Joonghyuk' safely.

It was then that I heard a rustling sound from the side. Jung Heewon, who suddenly came to her senses, was sitting up a few steps away from me.

"Ouch, it hurts. Inho-ssi. Are you okay? Did you get hurt?"

In a moment of panic, I quickly rushed toward her. Through the thick dust, the sound of Yoo Joonghyuk's footsteps stopped.

"That's weird."

I felt my heart drop.

"I'm sure it wasn't part of your plan to take such a woman with you."

Goosebumps spread from head to toe. Standing over the ruins, Yoo Joonghyuk stared at me with cold eyes.

I tried my best to hide my panic.

"What does it matter who I take with me?"

Instead of answering, Yoo Joonghyuk started walking back toward me.

An ominous feeling crept up on me. I instinctively felt a sense of crisis.

Now.

[You want to do something unexpected.]

[Describe your own behavior.]

[You have spent 5 probability points.]

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '■■' have been met.]

My writer's intuition was warning me. I had to use it now. If I failed to overcome this crisis, I would die.

[You have exhausted the number of additional entrances to the 'Snowfield'.]

[You will get a probability penalty.]

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

[Describe the next action of 'Cheon Inho'.]

> # Cheon Inho's Death
>
> ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■
>
> * At your current skill level, you can write a total of 150 additional characters.

[You have received a penalty.]

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield' for a total of 2 minutes.]

The title of the scene was terrible.

'Cheon Inho's Death'.

I quickly began to write a sentence. Roughly, it was about Cheon Inho convincing Yoo Joonghyuk with his amazing speech, overcoming the crisis and becoming his colleague.

[This story is very unlikely.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 1%.]

[You're running out of probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

> rlaehrwk37: Will Yoo Joonghyuk really accept Cheon Inho as his colleague?

I guess this was too much.

I decided to play the hidden card I had been saving.

「Then, Cheon Inho said. "Yoo Joonghyuk, you need a reliable companion. You can't break through the 46th scenario alone. Shouldn't you be well aware of it?"..... (147 characters in total)」

As I was writing this, I realized that this line could work, because it's exactly what Kim Dokja said in the original novel.

In other words, it was a cheat key that worked unconditionally.

[This story is out of character.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 3%.]

[You're running out of probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

> rlaehrwk81: Have you forgotten who you are?
>
> rlaehrwk37: A Cheon Inho has a Cheon Inho's life.

Yes, a Lee Hakhyun has a Lee Hakhyun's life, so let's write it down like Lee Hakhyun.

「Then, Cheon Inho said. "Yoo Joonghyuk. Actually, my name is not Cheon Inho, but Kim Dokja. I've read all of your novel and....." (149 characters in total)」

[This story is a mess.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 0.01%.]

「Then, Cheon Inho said. "Respected Yoo Joonghyuk, please make me your subordinate!"..... (148 characters in total)」

[This story is ordinary.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 3%.]

「Then, Cheon Inho said. "Actually, I'm a prophet..... (147 characters in total)」

[You story is impossible anyway.]

[The 'Snowfield' begins to doubt your talent.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 1%.]

Maybe this is the end of a Lee Hakhyun's life.

[There are 10 seconds remaining.]

I remembered Ji Eunyu's advice one last time.

「Now, what does Yoo Joonghyuk want?」

I closed my eyes and thought about it. And I realized.

[Failed to recreate the scene.]

There's no way I could know that. I can't even understand what he's saying right now, so how can I know what he wants?

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

[Your creativity has been exhausted. You can no longer enter the 'Snowfield' today.]

The colors returned to the world, and Yoo Joonghyuk's steps began to move again.

I swallowed and kept an eye on the situation. I had failed to recreate the scene, but I wasn't ready to give up yet.

"There are a lot of weirdos this round, right from the start."

Yoo Joonghyuk's dismal voice echoed through the cold night air.

"They were nothing until the last round, but they all suddenly came up to me and said strange things as if they were possessed."

I thought I knew what Yoo Joonghyuk was talking about now.

Wait. No way.

"They said that I needed a companion to break through the 46th scenario, or that they were prophets."

A cold sweat began to run down my back.

Yoo Joonghyuk was smiling with a strange expression.

"There was also one who said he would take me to the end of the world."

"Inho-ssi, step back."

Jung Heewon, who noticed something was strange, stood in front of me, holding the ground rat knife.

The next moment, Yoo Joonghyuk's figure disappeared.

The hairs on the back of my neck stood up, and I heard the sound of wind blowing in the distance. It was as if the Grim Reaper was speaking to me from the darkness. It was the implacable language of death that I could not answer.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' has used 'Kendo Lv.1'!]

Nevertheless, Jung Heewon answered him.

A creaking sound was heard in front of her, and dazzling sparks burst out in all directions.

Jung Heewon's sword, which received Yoo Joonghyuk's spear, was trembling precariously.

"You're good at Kendo. You're a similar type as Lee Jihye."

"Inho-ssi! Who is this person?"

As I looked at the blood dripping from Yoo Joonghyuk's spear pole, I had an eerie feeling.

I wanted to ask him, what happened to all those 'prophets' you met?

"Cheon Inho."

Yoo Joonghyuk turned to me.

"Are you really Cheon Inho?"

[The character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has used 'Lie Detection Lv.7'!]

His [Lie Detection] is level 7.

Perhaps, this was my last chance.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.3' is strongly activated!]

「I am Cheon Inho.」

In other words, as long as the acting was perfect, there was a possibility of deceiving him.

"If I'm not Cheon Inho, then who the hell is Cheon Inho. What are you doing?"

My heart was pounding.

And after a while,

[The character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

That's it. He'll have no choice but to believe me.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk's expression was strange.

"[Lie Detection] isn't always perfect, in the previous round you lied to me without using [Poker Face]."

"....."

"Cheon Inho. What was the first thing you decided to do?"

I was speechless for a moment.

"That."

If I made a mistake here, I could be caught by [Lie Detection].

Should I use [Incite] once more? Or—

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me with an unreadable gaze and said.

"I'll give you a chance."

Yoo Joonghyuk's spear instantly flashed, sending Jung Heewon's sword flying into the air.

Just as Jung Heewon reached out to grab the sword in surprise, Yoo Joonghyuk's spear moved once more.

The fight was quick to end.

Blood gushed from both her knees, and Jung Heewon, who lost her balance, fell forward.

Yoo Joonghyuk's left hand moved.

"Keok."

He lifted Jung Heewon's neck and moved to the end of the bridge.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked back in my direction and said.

"What I need is the great villain Cheon Inho, 'The One Who Deceived the Stars', the 'Evil Sophist'."

I don't know why Cheon Inho had such grandiose nicknames, but Yoo Joonghyuk's purpose was clear.

"If you're really the 'Cheon Inho' I know, prove it."

Yoo Joonghyuk's left hand moved slowly.

Jung Heewon's complexion turned pale as she struggled. Beneath her feet, the hell road of the Han River, where the ichthyosaur passed, unfolded.

Yoo Joonghyuk asked.

"Is this woman your colleague?"

Yoo Joonghyuk was testing me now.

Was I really the 'Cheon Inho' he remembered?

Jung Heewon was looking at me with trembling eyes.

Perhaps, there was only one way to save her now.

I slowly closed my eyes and opened them again. The cold night air rushed into my lungs, and for a moment, I felt like a different person.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.3' is strongly activated!]

[The synchronization rate with the possessed target is increasing rapidly!]

"Let me make one thing clear."

I said with my trademark sly smile, whispering the secret.

"I don't have any colleagues."

Deep disappointment flashed through Jung Heewon's eyes as she looked at me.

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

"That's definitely Cheon Inho."

I let out a breath of relief.

This was the right answer.

I was sure it was.

"Then it wouldn't matter if this woman died."

What?

Yoo Joonghyuk's hand opened wide, and Jung Heewon's body fell down.

I focused all my strength into my legs and flew toward her.

"As expected, you aren't Cheon Inho."

The world spun, and Jung Heewon and I began to plummet down the bridge.

The chilly breeze scratched my cheeks, and I could smell the fishy odor of water.

I looked up at the dizzying sight and saw Yoo Joonghyuk looking down at us from the bridge.

Release your hand and get lost, you son of a bitch.

The next thing I know, the cold water of the Han River assaulted my senses, and my vision turned black with shock.

And then a message came in.

[The dokkaebi 'Bihyung' has agreed to a 'Stream Contract' with you.]

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Author's Note

Don't let go of that hand...

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 573 Episode 4. An Unwalked Road (1)

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Episode 4. An Unwalked Road

「So we are each other's past, each other's future.」

—The Prophet Anna Croft.

---

Just before I collided with the surface, I felt like I was going to lose my mind, even though I had increased my physique with coins.

[1,800 coins have been invested into 'Physique'.]

[Physique Lv.4 → Physique Lv.10]

[Your physique level has increased dramatically!]

[Your physical durability has increased dramatically!]

[Coins Possessed: 1,800 C]

My body was numb from head to toe from the impact, and my ears were deafening. I could feel my body temperature dropping rapidly.

It was a message from the constellations that held my fading consciousness together.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' appreciates your survivability.]

[500 coins have been sponsored.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is sponsoring you!]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' is sponsoring you!]

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' is sponsoring you!]

[The constellation 'Dog Who Threw Himself into the Flames' is sponsoring you!]

[An additional 800 coins have been sponsored.]

I also saw the returning animal constellations' modifiers.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' likes your heartlessness.]

[300 coins have been sponsored.]

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' praises your repentance.]

[100 coins have been sponsored.]

Plus the Black Flame Dragon and Jophiel.

I gritted my teeth.

I'll just have to survive here somehow.

[Coins Possessed: 3,500 C]

As I held my breath and calmly scanned my surroundings, I saw Jung Heewon's glimmering figure.

Completely unconscious, her body was sinking deeper into the water.

I paddled toward her with all my might, but I couldn't save her with my ligament-torn arm. There was only one option.

I bit her arm hard.

I choked as the river rushed into my mouth. I thought my eyeballs were going to fall out. Still, I couldn't give up.

If Jung Heewon died here, this round would be over.

Slowly, the strength drained from my body. Even as my breathing faded, I didn't let go of her arm.

Wake up, please.

It was then that a strong splash of water came from somewhere.

As my breath caught in my throat, I saw a large monster coming toward us from the distance.

An ichthyosaur (魚龍).

7th grade monsters species, sea serpent.

Sharp teeth flashed before my eyes. Then, a pitch-dark silence filled my senses.

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk25: Missed it |

"Inho-ssi. Inho-ssi!"

I felt something slap my cheek, and slowly came back to consciousness. The first thing I saw when I opened my eyes was the blinding flash of a cell phone, and then Jung Heewon's face.

"Heewon-ssi?"

"Ha..... Really."

Jung Heewon breathed a sigh of relief. As I staggered to my feet, the ground suddenly tilted and shook.

Jung Heewon grabbed my shoulder.

"Be careful, or we'll sink."

The river raged in the darkness.

Upon closer inspection, I realized we were sitting on the remains of a small plastic structure. I wondered if it was the remains of a sailboat used by the Han River rescue team.

The air was strangely humid. I turned on my phone's flash and saw a wall of crimson above, below, and to the left.

In the back of my mind, I remembered what happened before I lost consciousness.

We had been eaten by an ichthyosaur.

"You seem happy to have survived. We're about to die."

I threw up water and smiled bitterly.

The light from my cell phone cast the shadows of the two of us against the crimson stomach of the ichthyosaur.

"Heewon-ssi."

"Never mind."

Jung Heewon spoke without looking in my direction, as if she already knew what I was going to say.

"Inho-ssi, you're a bit of a weirdo."

"I'm kind of like that."

"You always say weird things."

First I said I loved her, then I said she's not even my colleague.

Jung Heewon must be confused.

If I had a friend like Cheon Inho, I would have cut him off immediately.

"I'm sorry, though. I didn't mean it. I thought he would let Heewon-ssi go if I told him so."

"He's a psychopath, isn't he?"

I thought for a moment before answering.

"That's right."

"A friend?"

"Not a friend."

"I guess he's someone you know."

I nodded lightly.

She was silent for a moment, as if she was thinking about something, and then she spoke up.

"By the way, it hurts. How hard did you bite me?"

A human tooth mark was clearly visible on her right forearm.

Embarrassed, I replied.

"I'm sorry."

"I'm glad you did it, though. I woke up because it really hurt."

"Are you hurt anywhere else? The wound from the fight earlier—"

"It's fine, it's a really shallow cut."

.....A shallow cut? From that 'Yoo Joonghyuk'?

"Anyway, what should we do now? We're trapped."

I measured the size of the stomach surrounding us. Fortunately, it didn't seem to be the sea commander that swallowed Kim Dokja.

"It's for the best. We're safer here than in the Han River."

"What if we melt with its digestive juices?"

"We need to escape before that happens."

"How? We're not Pinocchio."

"Pinocchio?"

"Don't you know?"

"No, I know."

Isn't she talking about the wooden puppet whose nose grows longer every time he lies?

"Well, Pinocchio got eaten by a whale and escaped."

I remembered reading that fairy tale a long time ago.

Jung Heewon seemed to think that we were in a similar situation.

[The constellation 'Long-Nosed Liar' nods.]

I stared at the message blankly, then snapped out of it.

"Let me gather my thoughts for a moment, I think we need to come up with a plan."

"Okay. What should I do?"

"Well..... If you remember how Pinocchio escaped from the whale's stomach, tell me."

"Do you think that will help?"

"Just in case."

Of course, Pinocchio didn't tell us how to escape from an ichthyosaur.

「That will be Omniscient Reader.」

While Jung Heewon was seriously pondering, I closed my eyes and recalled the sequence of how

Kim Dokja escaped from here.

But in order to use this method, I needed someone's help.

'Bihyung.'

Soon, I felt the 'dokkaebi communication' connect.

—Hoo..... So this is how it turned out.

Bihyung sounded dejected.

—I don't know why so many strange things are happening this season.

'Have you considered my offer?'

—I sent you a message saying I'm signing the contract, didn't you get it?

With those words, a window popped up in front of me.

| |
|---|
| ----<Stream Contract Agreement><br><br>1. Incarnation Cheon Inho (hereinafter referred to as gap) will sign an exclusive contract with the<br><br>dokkaebi Bihyung (hereinafter referred to as eul) until all scenarios are completed or until his<br><br>death.<br><br>..... |

----It felt strange to see this contract again.

—This is really special, I wasn't going to do it originally.....

It wasn't hard to figure out when Bihyung made up his mind.

Probably, right after seeing the confrontation between Yoo Joonghyuk and me. Judging by the coins that came in earlier, I guess the constellations watched the confrontation with interest.

I quickly checked Bihyung's contract, checking off the oddities and crossing off the concessions.

—You're pretty good at this, huh?

'Because all contracts are similar.'

In fact, the 'Stream Contract Agreement' looked a lot like the 'Management Contract Agreement'

I always sign.

Suddenly, I remembered my days as a rookie writer, when I was a victim of contract scams.

—The ratio is 8:2. You'll have 8 and I'll have 2.

'That's fine with me, but isn't it supposed to be 7:3?'

—I saw how you did back then, so I thought it was okay to give you more.

He was probably worried about losing me to another dokkaebi.

A wise move, but it puts the hilt of the sword in my hands.

'Well, while you're at it, I have one more favor to ask.'

—No more ratio adjustments. This is the best I can do.

'Enough with the ratios, give me the scenario.'

—Scenario?

'There's a hidden scenario here.'

Bihyung was speechless for a moment.

—How do you even know that?

'Does it matter?'

Bihyung sighed again, and muttered something to himself about the Bureau, probability and sanctions.

—Well, yeah. There's a guy who already received this one.

Someone already received this scenario?

[A new hidden scenario has arrived!]

I checked the scenario window.

**<Hidden Scenario - Serpent Slayer>**

Category: Hidden

Difficulty: B

Clear Conditions: Kill the ichthyosaur 'sea serpent' and escape from its stomach.

Time Limit: 5 days

Reward: 4,000 coins

Failure: Death

The reward isn't as good as Kim Dokja's Hidden Scenario, but it's less challenging.

This should be enough to get the injured me and Jung Heewon through.

—No more objections to the contract? Do you need anything else?

'You'll have to give me the right to use the Dokkaebi Bag.'

The 'Dokkaebi Bag'.

In fact, this was the biggest benefit from the 'stream contract'.

Bihyung immediately pulled up the 'Dokkaebi Bag's screen in front of me.

'Don't you have to put up an advertisement?'

—Advertisement?

'Wouldn't you get in trouble if someone found out I was using the Dokkaebi Bag?'

Bihyung spoke bitterly, as if he was worried about something like that.

—It's not illegal, and you're not the only one who benefits from the Dokkaebi Bag, so it doesn't matter.

In fact, the constellations didn't seem to mind that I was using the Dokkaebi Bag.

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' wonders what you'll buy.]

Instead, they seemed to be watching with interest to see what I would buy. It was definitely a change of pace from the original novel.

Anyway, I've got everything I need.

'Let's sign then.'

[The stream contract has concluded.]

[You have received 1,000 coins as a down payment.]

Plus an unspoken down payment.....

Is Bihyung actually a good guy?

Maybe Kim Dokja, who turned his back on such an honest dokkaebi, was a worse bastard?

—I have to go to another area, so contact me if you need anything.

It seemed that Bihyung had many other areas to pay attention to besides mine.

I was rather relieved.

It could mean that there were many surviving readers in this world.

'Be careful.'

After the 'dokkaebi communication' was cut off, I immediately opened the 'Dokkaebi Bag'.

[The product search function is activated.]

[The product search function is limited to 5 times a day. Any additional searches will cost 100 coins per search.]

The benefits of the bag are the same as in the original novel.

I made a list in my head of items I wanted to get ahead of time.

Ancient Dragon's Heart, Great Demon's Eyes. There were a few other items I'd created as settings, but the first thing to search for was this item.

[The related product search is completed.]

The first item Kim Dokja gets in the main novel.

| |
|---|
| *Purest Sword Force (白淸罡氣) - Stock: 0 |

No, it's already sold out?

Apparently, another reader could open the 'Dokkaebi Bag' first and bought it.

"I think Pinocchio."

Suddenly I heard a voice, so I reflexively turned around.

Jung Heewon was muttering something to me with a serious face.

"I wonder if he lied so hard that he grew a very long nose and escaped by blowing a hole in the whale's stomach?"

I stared at her blankly.

I couldn't believe she was still thinking about Pinocchio.

"That's a good idea."

Jung Heewon narrowed her eyes at my praise.

"It's not."

"No, it's a really good idea. It's kind of what I was going to do."

I opened the 'Dokkaebi Bag' again and searched for the items.

'Mucus of the Hammer Seahorse' and 'Stone Hog's Pointed Thorn'.

Both were items that Kim Dokja purchased to escape from the ichthyosaur.

In the main story, Kim Dokja buys four of each of these items.

I bought eight of each.

[1,600 coins have been consumed.]

I was tempted to look up the other items, but I didn't have the coins to do so right now anyway.

I stuck one of the thorns into my waistband with my ungainly right hand, then handed the remaining seven thorns and eight mucus bags to Jung Heewon.

"Take these."

Jung Heewon asked in surprise.

"Where did you get all of this from all of a sudden?"

"This is the key to Operation Pinocchio."

"What?"

Again, I can't carry out this operation alone.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is looking at you with interest.]

Both my arms are crippled right now.

Therefore, I need someone else to insert the thorns into the stomach wall like Kim Dokja did.

I looked up at the digestive juices throughout the stomach wall and said.

"From now on, think of this thorn as Pinocchio's nose."

Luckily, I could borrow Kim Dokja's wisdom this time.

---

That night, I had a dream.

I wasn't really trying to sleep, more like I passed out for a bit.

Usually, when I have a dream, I say something along the lines of 'what did I dream'. If a pig appeared, it's a dream of a pig. If a dragon appeared, it's a dream of a dragon.

Well, I suppose you could give this dream a name.

This dream,

「Cheon Inho.」

It was a dream of a Kim Dokja.

---

Author's Note

The Oldest Dream?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 574 Episode 4. An Unwalked Road (2)

In my dream, Kim Dokja called me Cheon Inho. However, when I listened carefully, it sounded like he was calling me Lee Hakhyun.

No, when I listened again.....

「■■■.」

I'm not sure what he was saying.

But there he was, and I was standing next to him.

We were looking at a very large snowfield.

A snowfield with letters floating on it.

It was so big, it seemed like no matter how many letters there were, they would never be able to cover it all.

「How long have you been here?」

I may or may not have asked that question.

「A very long time.」

I don't know if that's what Kim Dokja said or not.

As I stared at the snowfield for a while, I noticed something like footprints.

They were human footprints.

As if to test the waters, he gestured at me and started walking along the footprints.

I followed him too.

「This person must have really big feet.」

We walked, overlapping our footprints on top of each other. Occasionally, I'd take a wrong step and leave a footprint in the wrong place.

「Ah.」

Kim Dokja laughed, and I laughed, too.

「■■■ is going to get angry.」

I could almost hear him saying that.

And I wonder how long we walked.

I don't know why, but the big footprints split into two directions. One big footprint kept moving forward, and the other big footprint started walking diagonally.

So were there two people leaving big footprints from the beginning?

I couldn't be sure.

They were all the same size.

I'm not sure why, but here the owners of the big footprints suddenly split. One walked straight ahead, and the other walked diagonally.

I stared at the path of the footprints in front of me, and then tried to follow them for a few steps.

I must have taken a dozen steps.

「It stopped.」

The footprints stopped here.

Where had the owner of these footprints gone?

A strange thought occurred to me as I stared at the footprints.

Perhaps the owner of the footprints was still standing on them.

When I turned around, Kim Dokja was standing tall and looking in my direction.

I waved at him and asked.

「Can I keep walking this way?」

Kim Dokja nodded.

I asked again.

「I might make a mistake like I did before.」

「It's okay.」

「I might make a mess of the snowfield.」

「It doesn't matter.」

Is it really okay?

I wanted to ask again, and again, and again.

Kim Dokja smiled and said something. Unfortunately, I couldn't hear his last words.

「I'll keep watching you.」

It sounded like that.

---

"Inho-ssi! Inho-ssi!"

My whole body ached: the wound in my side throbbed and the pain in my broken left arm was excruciating.

"You said you weren't going to sleep! It's already started!"

"Uh, sorry."

I must have fallen asleep. I wondered why I had such a fairy tale-like dream.

"Pinocchio wasn't good during the operation either."

I guess it was because I heard about Pinocchio. Kim Dokja's last words still echoed in my head.

When I looked around, the stomach was already pumping out digestive juices.

Jung Heewon was spraying 'Mucus of the Hammer Seahorse' all over my head. My shoulders slumped as the sticky liquid trickled down.

"Stay still, you said it's safe to apply this."

Jung Heewon smeared her own body with the Mucus of the Hammer Seahorse.

Our plan was simple.

One, smear our entire bodies with mucus to resist the ichthyosaur's digestive juices.

Two, when the digestive juices start spewing, stick a 'Stone Hog's Pointed Thorn' into the openings.

This is the exact same tactic that Kim Dokja did in the original novel.

The difference is.....

"By the way, who's Kim Dokja?"

"What?"

"You mentioned him in your sleep."

"Oh."

I thought for a moment, then opened my mouth.

"It's just a friend's name."

Jung Heewon asked, squeezing my mucus-covered head.

"Then what about Ji Eunyu?"

"Did I say that name too?"

"Yes. You asked me to save you."

Did I have a deadline in my dreams?

"It's the name of my editor."

"Your editor?"

I thought it would be okay to be a little honest. I didn't know what Cheon Inho's real job was anyway. He was probably a swindler or something.

"I used to be a writer."

Still, it's better to be a writer than a swindler.

Jung Heewon asked in surprise.

"Wow, a writer? What kind of books did you write?"

"That..... Do you know web novels?"

"Web novels? Is it like a webtoon?"

"That..... like Lord of the Rings....."

"Oh, Lord of the Rings! I've seen the movies! Is that what you wrote?"

"Well, something similar....."

I don't know why my voice kept getting lower.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is asking you to speak up.]

Easier said than done.

I sighed lightly and said.

"Would you mind not telling the others?"

"Why? I think it's cool."

This is why you shouldn't introduce yourself.

"Let's start with that side first. Hold this and insert one on each opening."

"Maybe because you're a writer you're good at changing the subject."

Jung Heewon grumbled, but stuck the thorns where I pointed.

As expected, the physicality of a main character was truly something else.

There were four openings.

Jung Heewon stuck one thorn into each of the three openings, then closed them tightly to keep the digestive juices from flowing out.

"There's only one left."

"Let's shove the rest of them into this one opening."

"Is that okay?"

"Yes. It'll probably work better."

The 'Stone Hog's Pointed Thorn' is an item that grows by sucking the fluids of sea species.

Kim Dokja had only used one thorn for each opening.

But in theory, the more thorns you put in an opening, the better.

The more thorns there are, the more thorns will grow at the same time, and the faster the ichthyosaur will fall.

"One."

Digestive juices gurgled out of the thorn.

The second thorn was inserted, and the ichthyosaur's stomach began to wriggle grotesquely.

It wasn't so easy from the third thorn on. Jung Heewon frowned as she stuck the thorn into the hole again and again.

"After the third one, it's a bit difficult, can you..... support me from the back?"

"I'd love to, but my arms are like this."

"Support me with your back. Like this."

I stood with my back against Jung Heewon's back. Inhaling and exhaling, she pushed the thorn with all her might into the opening.

The part we were standing on shook for a moment, but the thorn went in just right.

After taking a breath, Jung Heewon asked.

"Are we done?"

"Yes. Now we just have to wait."

"It's really simple."

The job was done faster than I thought. In the main novel, Kim Dokja even practiced stabbing to get this done... Why did he struggle so much anyway?

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' admires your composure.]

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier says it's easy because it's a 'sea serpent'.]

According to my calculations, the time it'll take to subdue the ichthyosaur is half a day to a day.

Considering the number of thorns it has, and the fact that it's smaller than the original, it could go down sooner than that.

Now it was just a matter of waiting.

I felt a sudden chill rush through me as I relaxed, probably because I was soaking wet from the river.

Jung Heewon looked at me wistfully as I shivered, then made an unexpected suggestion.

"Shall we stand back to back?"

"If you don't mind, may we?"

"Please sit that way."

We meekly sat back to back. The warmth of Jung Heewon's body transmitted through my back, and I felt a little less cold.

Jung Heewon asked.

"By the way, how did you come up with this method?"

"It's just something that often appears in web novels."

"You're a writer, I see."

As my back warmed up, I slowly dozed off.

I wish I could use the 'Elaine Forest Essence' sold in the Dokkaebi Bag, but I couldn't right now.

The Elaine Forest Essence recovers your body's wounds completely while you sleep.

I couldn't leave her alone without knowing what would happen.

She kept talking to me as if she knew my condition.

"Tell me something funny."

This was the most embarrassing moment of my life as a writer.

In fact, writers are not very funny people. None of the writers I know are funny.

Still, I managed to squeeze out some dry humor.

"In my novel, there's a character named Jung Heewon."

"What?"

"She looks really strong on the outside, but she's actually a fragile person. She doesn't shy away from fights because she's a very hard person, so she often breaks."

I thought of the 'Jung Heewon' I knew.

Suddenly, I had a question.

Can I really say that the Jung Heewon I know is the Jung Heewon behind my back now?

I continued.

"She's good at physical work and has a quick mind. When she was in high school, she was confessed to by junior girls."

"....."

"She's bad at bearing public criticism, but she's good at kendo. She's been going to a kendo academy since she was a kid."

Jung Heewon, who had been listening until here, clapped her hands. She was genuinely impressed.

"That's great, you almost got it all right."

Of course I did. Most of it comes from the main novel.

"But the last one is wrong, I never went to a kendo academy, I just went to kendo club at school."

I know. I said that on purpose.

"That's a shame."

"I went to the nationals, and I was elected district representative, but I quit."

"Why?"

"Because of an injury."

This was a story I didn't know.

More accurately, it was a story I hadn't written.

"Injury? Were you hurt badly?"

Jung Heewon was silent for a moment, and then, a beat too late, she answered.

"Yes."

It hit me like a ton of bricks. There must be a story in this world that I didn't write.

I suddenly remembered that Jung Heewon's attribute was 'Crouching Figure'.

How did she become a 'Crouching Figure'?

Originally, 'Crouching Figure' is an attribute that is generated based on the strong mental shock of an incarnation.

However, Jung Heewon was already a 'Crouching Figure' before she met the Cheoldoo Group.

"Inho-ssi, how did you become a writer?"

"Oh, I..."

I naturally opened my mouth to speak, but I shut up again. An eerie sensation flickered across my chest.

「How did I become a writer?」

I suddenly couldn't remember.

It was then that the ichthyosaur's stomach wriggled ominously.

I quickly kept my balance and said.

"I think it's about to start."

There was no time for distractions now.

The fight was about to begin.

The ichthyosaur would go down first, or we would go down first?

I took off the shirt I was wearing and used both sleeves to tie Jung Heewon's and my wrists together.

Jung Heewon asked anxiously.

"Aren't you going to get cold? Ugh!"

The floor vibrated sharply.

The ichthyosaur was twisting its body in pain. The thorns had begun to dig into its body in earnest.

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Author's Note

Meanwhile, there is more.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 575 Episode 4. An Unwalked Road (3)

We stood side by side, holding on to one of the thorns.

"You can't pass out!"

"Don't worry!"

I said, but I wasn't sure if my physical strength would hold up.

Normally, I would have used my 'Elaine Forest Essence' to heal my wounds and get moving, but I was in a hurry now that I'd lost [Purest Sword Force].

The sooner I could get out of here and get the other hidden pieces, the safer I would be.

Especially if this world is the one I think it is.

What happened to Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi? I need to tell them about the 'Yoo Joonghyuk' I saw as soon as possible.

My eyelids kept dropping.

I don't know how many times I blacked out and woke up again.

"Wake up!"

Jung Heewon pinched my waist with her left arm.

"Inho-ssi!"

"Ah."

The ichthyosaur's movements had slowed down. The crimson-colored stomach walls had turned almost grayish white.

"I think it's done. Just a little more to go....."

It was then that something unexpected happened.

I heard a sound like a wind leak from somewhere, and a large, sharp set of teeth appeared, slicing through the guts from the outside.

I instinctively screamed.

"Hold your breath!"

The black river rushed in through the cracks.

We clung to each other's arms and were swept away into the Han River.

[An error has occurred in the hidden scenario.]

[The hidden scenario was partially completed.]

Something attacked the ichthyosaur, targeting the 'stomach'.

The gut of the torn ichthyosaur scattered in the dark river. Through the swirling blood, two hideous eyes glared at me.

A monster twice as large as the one that had devoured us.

I recognized it immediately.

The ichthyosaur that swallowed Kim Dokja.

Sea-commander.

My heart sank as I saw the sea commander charging to devour us and Jung Heewon's horrified expression.

「Jung Heewon is going to die.」

From the first scenario to being eaten by the ichthyosaur, what I did ran through my head like a movie.

How I had changed the story with the arrogance of writing the original.

I shouldn't have rehabilitated the Cheoldoo Group.

I shouldn't have gone out looking for Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk.

「Are you really Cheon Inho?」

It would have been better if I had been killed by Jung Heewon while pretending to be a villain like in the original novel. Then she would have awakened safely as the 'Judge of Destruction'.

She would have survived.

I began to untie the knot on my right arm with my teeth.

Jung Heewon looked back at me in horror.

When I finished, I felt rather at peace.

「This is a fitting end for the villain Cheon Inho.」

My body slowly sank beneath the water, along with the loose knot.

Bubbles of air flowed out of Jung Heewon's mouth as she shouted something at me.

I saw the sea commander opening his mouth at me and Jung Heewon reaching for me.

In my fading consciousness, I heard the tick, tick, tick of time stopping.

[A new day has begun.]

[Your creativity has been recharged.]

I realized what was about to happen.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' wants to do something unexpected.]

[The exclusive skill '■■' is activated!]

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

Looking at the blank space in front of me, a bitter laugh escaped from my dwindling consciousness.

Damn it. I'm supposed to write until I die.

| |
|---|
| # Jung Heewon's Awakening<br><br>■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■<br><br>* At your current skill level, you can write a total of 180 additional characters. |

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield' for a total of 4 minutes.]

I looked at the first sentence of the blank line.

「Jung Heewon.」

I wonder if it's okay if I keep writing.

[There are 3 minutes remaining.]

For some reason, I was not confident. Something was different from Kim Cheolyang and Bang Cheolsoo.

I remembered how I felt as a child when I received my first manuscript.

As I looked at the vague blank page, I naturally remembered the snowy landscape I saw with Kim Dokja.

In my dream, Kim Dokja said.

「It's dazzling.」

He said.

「Anything can become a reality in this place.」

It snowed heavily from the sky, and we lay side by side in the snow and looked back at the footprints we walked together. Before I knew it, the footprints were hard to see.

「Because no one remembers what they were.」

I don't remember if he said that.

But the spot where I laid with Kim Dokja was strangely comfortable and warm. If I could, I wanted to stay there forever, curled up in a tight ball and writing nothing.

Nevertheless, I couldn't.

Because I am a writer.

「Jung Heewon remembered that day」

If I don't write, I can't live.

「for the first time in a long time.」

So I wrote the sentence.

I chose words like I would choose clothes for Jung Heewon, and I chose endings like I would choose shoes for her.

I imagined her wearing those shoes, walking down a road that no one remembers.

[This story might be possible.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 50%.]

[Current Accumulated Probability: 10]

[You can increase the reproduction success rate by investing more probability.]

'I'll do it.'

[You have spent 10 probability points.]

[You can write an additional 160 characters.]

I continued to write sentence after sentence.

Would these lies I wrote save her life.

I don't know.

But I had to try everything I could.

[This story is plausible.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 88%.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

'Yes.'

There were three comments this time.

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk37: Cheer up<br>rlaehrwk61: Cheer up<br>rlaehrwk99: Cheer up |

I thought, my mouth open in disbelief.

Thank you.

[Successfully recreating the scene.]

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

Time began to pass again. My breathing unraveled, and weak bubbles escaped my mouth.

I didn't write about whether I would survive; there was no room for that.

But I did write at least one thing for sure.

「Jung Heewon remembered that day for the first time in a long time.」

That you, who live this story, will surely survive.

「'Heewon, you're too aggressive. This is a sport. You can't really hurt your opponent.'」

「'This month alone, three people have quit because of you. There's a kid with a broken arm. If you continue like this, I won't be able to keep protecting you.'」

A pure white light emanated from Jung Heewon's body.

「Jung Heewon couldn't quite understand the coach's words. Wasn't the sword made to kill opponents?」

Kim Dokja once said. He said that he likes the moment a character's attribute blossoms the most.

「Isn't it more strange if you don't get hurt while fighting with a sword?」

Now I agree with Kim Dokja.

[The attribute of the character 'Jung Heewon' is blossoming.]

I couldn't put it any other way.

The figure of Jung Heewon, who is now cutting through the tide and approaching, is truly dazzling.

Her hot hands grabbed my hands strongly. I felt my body being firmly anchored.

Jung Heewon looked back at the sea commander as she clutched the ground rat knife.

Riding the rapids, she swooped toward the sea commander as if she had wings.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' has used 'Kendo Lv.3'!]

[The character 'Jung Heewon' has used 'Demon Slaying Lv.2'!]

No matter how strong Jung Heewon is, she can't defeat a sea commander with just [Kendo] and [Demon Slaying].

But I wrote that it is possible. So it should be possible.

It will be possible.

「Jung Heewon wanted to ask the coach.」

It is possible.

「'Is it okay to kill this thing?'」

In my fading consciousness, the words were slurred.

Somewhere in the distance, I could hear Jung Heewon's shout.

「The dormant senses in her soul were awakening.」

In the blink of an eye, the ground rat sword broke through the spray and plunged into the sea commander's left eye. The bleeding sea commander howled wildly.

Jung Heewon didn't stop and pulled the thorn from my waistband. The sea commander's tail cut through the water and grazed her waist.

The enormous impact jolted the view.

She squinted her bloodshot eyes, clutched me tightly with one arm, and drove the thorn into the ichthyosaur's tail.

「'This is not a sport.'」

That was a sentence I didn't write.

「'If I don't kill this monster, someone else will die.'」

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon's will.]

And a message came from somewhere.

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon's will.]

The light emanating from her body grew stronger and stronger.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon's will.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon's will.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon's will.]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon's will.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon's will.]

.....

I felt an invisible Libra tilting.

[All constellations in the channel agree to the use of the skill.]

['Hour of Judgment' has been activated.]

Hour of Judgment.

A skill that grants invincibility when activated against the wicked.

However, the enemy in front of us was a monster.

[The attribute of the character 'Jung Heewon' has blossomed to 'Demon Slaying Judge (Hero)'.]

With a dazzling flash of light, a blood-colored aura enveloped Jung Heewon's body.

Demon Slaying (滅魔) Judge.

Surely, there was such an attribute. It was one of the three great judges' attributes, but it hadn't appeared in the main story.

It wasn't a class that specialized in hand-to-hand combat like the Judge of Destruction, but it was an indestructible hero class that increased its combat power many times against monsters.

[You have contributed greatly to the blossoming of the attribute 'Crouching Figure'!]

[The character 'Jung Heewon' won't hesitate to be your sword in the future.]

With an eerie trajectory, the thorn moved forward and stabbed the sea commander's body.

Jung Heewon stabbed and stabbed and stabbed at the sea commander like a madman. From the tail, to the body, to the neck, to the crown.

When she finally stabbed the second eye, it jerked as if it had been electrocuted, and then went limp.

Its lifeless body floated to the surface of the Han River.

Jung Heewon, with me on her back, soared into the sky on the back of the sea commander.

Along with the rushing river, I could see the ruined city of Seoul.

Smoke rising from everywhere. Collapsed buildings, and the indifferent moon hanging over the ruins of civilization.

The destruction I wrote became the landscape.

「'Dazzling.'」

Looking at the landscape of the end of the world as we knew it, Jung Heewon was thinking the same thing I was.

Perhaps this was the landscape that Kim Dokja and Jung Heewon shared.

['Hour of Judgment' has ended.]

And now I was looking at that astounding world with her.

Jung Heewon, who had landed on the ground with me on her back, fell forward.

In the distance, I could see a poisonous mist rolling in.

I tied another knot in her arm, then dragged her to the basement of a nearby building to hide.

[You have bought 2 'Elaine Monkey's Lungs'.]

I popped a lung into Jung Heewon's mouth, and I popped a lung into mine.

Starlight streamed in from the basement window. It was a little cold, and strangely, my heart didn't stop pounding.

The night of destruction was long.

I looked at Jung Heewon as she slept and thought long and hard about the lies I had written and would write in the future.

On the Han River, in the solitary moonlight.

The dead sea commander's stomach lurched several times, and then a figure crawled out of the faded scales.

"Ha, I almost died. Really."

She brushed the blood off her coat and looked around, sighing softly.

"That's the first time I've ever had a scenario stolen from me, by the way. What an asshole."

But there was no one to hear her.

Well, there was one.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' chuckles and says this place is a bit unusual.]

"What are you laughing at, dude. Why do you have that modifier?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' asks what's wrong with his modifier.]

"What about the others?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says not yet.]

She pursed her lips lightly, as if in disbelief, and sighed deeply again.

After a moment, she looked up, an odd smile tugging at the corners of her mouth.

"Well, it's my first scenario in a long time."

Her eyes sparkled intensely for a moment as she stared off into space, searching for a star somewhere in the night sky.

"I'm going to live for myself first."

---

Author's Note

Gasp

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 576 Episode 5. Villain (1)

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Episode 5. Villain

「Kim Dokja is the real mastermind」

—Comment from chapter 516 of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint

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When a person faints frequently, there comes a moment when they realize that they are fainting.

If Ji Eunyu, the editor in charge, had heard me, she would have said, "If you know that, you haven't fainted," leaving me in a state of philosophical tension. But fortunately, Ji Eunyu was not here.

So, to put it simply,

「I have fainted now.」

At this rate, I'm probably going to faint more than Kim Dokja, the "fainting man", so that's not good.

I forced my eyes open.

It was pitch black.

I hadn't woken up yet. I blinked hard, again and again, but all I could see was darkness.

Something about this darkness felt familiar.

And the feel of the chair against my back. The comfort of my arms on the armrests.

This was a theater.

To be precise, it looked a lot like the theater where 'Kim Dokja's Banquet' took place.

When I casually glanced to the side, there were children sitting in the empty seats.

I wondered if they were watching a movie as a group, but when I looked closer, I saw that they were all Kim Dokja.

I felt a chill down my spine.

I was thinking about Kim Dokja too much.

Is that why I'm having this crazy dream?

I rubbed my eyes and looked around again.

I looked again, and they were indeed kkoma Kim Dokjas.

They didn't seem to notice me at all, and most of them were looking ahead, yawning, or doing something else.

I couldn't figure out what I was dreaming about, both symbolically and metaphorically.

「"Oh, shit, this is crazy, this is ridiculous."」

A voice came from the screen, as if echoing my thoughts.

I looked at the screen along the Kim Dokjas. A movie had been playing there for some time.

「"Ahjussi! Wake up!"」

Through the pile of rubble, I could see the faces of Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi.

I had a rough idea of what was going on. It must have happened right after I fell off the Dongho Bridge.

After spitting out the dirt in his mouth, Dansoo ahjussi asked.

「"What happened to Inho-ssi?"」

As soon as he woke up, Dansoo ahjussi looked for me.

The first colleague I met.

I could tell by his expression: he was genuinely worried about me.

「"I don't know."」

Kyung Sein said, shaking her head helplessly.

"I remember Inho-ssi pushing us, but....."

"Maybe he was trying to save us."」

The two began to search the area, as if looking for any trace of me, and it wasn't long before they spotted something in the collapsed ruins.

"There is a monster....."」

Seeing the body of the poisonous rhinoceros, Kyung Sein's expression hardened.

「At that moment, she realized what had happened.」

Her voice trembled slightly as she continued.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"I think he's left now."

"Do you think Inho-ssi went with him?"

"I don't think so..... There are traces of someone fighting here."

"A fight?"

"I think so. I think Yoo Joonghyuk might have attacked them first....."

"Then Inho-ssi and Heewon-ssi—"

After a moment of silence, Kyung Sein said as if determined.

「"I'm sure they're not dead. You know Inho-ssi isn't just a regular reader."」

Kyung Sein glanced toward the tunnel leading to Geumho Station.

「In fact, she was already awake when Yoo Joonghyuk passed by her. But she didn't move immediately. That's because her skill [Sixth Sense] warned her.」

She had such a skill.

「[Sixth Sense] was telling her. If you wake up now, you will surely die. So Kyung Sein kept pretending to faint until Yoo Joonghyuk's presence completely disappeared.」

If she had moved then, she might have really died.

Looking toward the direction of Dongho Bridge, where Jung Heewon and I had fallen, Kyung Sein clenched her fists and spoke.

"But Inho-ssi is still....."

"If Inho-ssi and Heewon-nim are alive, they'll go there too. We don't know what's around, so it's dangerous for us to stay here by ourselves."

"....."」

Ahjussi had lingering eyes, but Kyung Sein's judgment was correct. The two of them would certainly have a hard time when they couldn't even catch a single ground rat.

「"You saw the dead one-horned rhinoceros, it's impossible for us to find the two of them on our own. We should come back with the Cheoldoo Group..... if they're still alive."

Suddenly, I realized I could trust her in my absence.

She knew exactly what resources we had. I also liked the fact that she didn't forget to check.

The determined kkoma Kim Dokja was smiling subtly, as if he liked that fact.

The girl knows what she's doing.

「There is one thing Kyung Sein must do first. Prevent Yoo Joonghyuk from destroying the Cheoldoo Group.」

At best, I've incited Bang Cheolsoo to remove the danger from Geumho Station. We can't let that crazy Yoo Joonghyuk destroy our peaceful Geumho Station.

Dansoo ahjussi finally agreed, and the two of them hurried to Geumho Station.

Along the way, when they encountered a group of ground rats, they ran away from them, and when one appeared, they bravely fought it off.

I wonder how long they ran like that.

Finally, Geumho Station appeared in front of them.

Kyung Sein stood against the tunnel wall, stopping Dansoo ahjussi from entering the station.

「"Wait."」

Sharing her vision, I felt a chill in the pit of my stomach.

A black coat fluttered in the light breeze.

「There was Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Yoo Joonghyuk looked up and down Geumho Station, then tilted his head in disbelief.

「"A total of 134 people. That's strange. How did so many survive?"」

That psychopathic bastard. If a lot of people survived, you should be glad.

Apparently, a man at Geumho Station was thinking the same thing.

「"Who are you?"」

The men walked toward Yoo Joonghyuk with a stern expression. It was the Cheoldoo Group.

「"I'm asking you, who are you?"」

In exactly three steps, the man's limbs twisted and he fell to the ground.

At least Kim Dokja and I were in good shape, but we were beaten up after making a statement.

When I looked over, I saw that kkoma Kim Dokja had an insidious grin on his face.

"W-what's going on!"」

As the man screamed, Bang Cheolsoo and the rest of the Cheoldoo Group, who had noticed the commotion, rushed over.

Thanks to my training, Bang Cheolsoo didn't lunge at him spitting profanities, but instead asked calmly.

"Bang Cheolsoo. Are you the leader?"」

Bang Cheolsoo thought for a moment.

I wondered if he was already gauging the angle of betrayal.

「"Our leader is a man named Cheon Inho."」

Luckily, he didn't betray me, but it didn't make things any better.

「"Cheon Inho has already taken over."」

Yoo Joonghyuk started to misunderstand. He shook his head a few times, then looked around as if he had the whole situation figured out.

「"Cheon Inho is already dead. The marginalized group can come out in peace. I'll show you how to get food from now on."」

But none of the people moved, just stared at Yoo Joonghyuk with fear in their eyes and stepped back. Some of them were shocked to hear that I was dead.

Yoo Joonghyuk spoke again.

"There is no such thing as a marginalized group. What are you talking about?"

"Shut up."」

Under Yoo Joonghyuk's grip, Bang Cheolsoo's body fell to the ground. Yoo Joonghyuk crushed the wriggling Bang Cheolsoo with his foot. He looked at the people of the station and said.

"Kuk, my....."

"The scenarios ahead will not be easy. If you don't move now, you'll live as slaves forever."」

This was Yoo Joonghyuk's first encounter with the people of Geumho Station.

It was unexpected. He must have seen the same scene and said the same words dozens of times.

By the way, that bastard Yoo Joonghyuk talks like an army instructor, despite being incomplete himself.

I looked over and saw kkoma Kim Dokja nodding his head.

Somehow, I thought I'd like this kkoma.

「"You won't be this lucky in the future. Those of you who want to survive, move forward right now—"

"Let him go!」

I wondered if there was a kkoma Kim Dokja over there, too, but it wasn't him but a girl I didn't recognize.

A woman who appeared to be the girl's mom came running out and quickly hugged her.

"But that bad guy is bullying Cheolsoo ahjussi!"」

Suddenly, I remembered who the mother and daughter were.

Aka 'Dayoung and her mother'.

There were definitely people like that in Geumho Station.

A member of the marginalized group who fought against the 'mainstream group' in the main story of 'Omniscient Reader'.

Dayoung shouted.

「"Cheolsoo ahjussi didn't do anything wrong! Why are you bullying him!"」

Dayoung's mom quickly hid her behind her. But her daughter's cries moved her.

Finally, Dayoung's mom spoke up.

「"Why are you doing this? What do you want?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyebrows shot up at her words.

"They weren't threatened. I don't know what the hell you're talking about....."

"He took away your food. He used you as slaves, and he sent suicide commandos on the ground in the name of scouting. And you're going to forgive him for that?"」

With those words, Yoo Joonghyuk kicked Bang Cheolsoo on the floor once more.

Dayoung's mother couldn't take it anymore, so she pulled him to his feet. Bang Cheolsoo lowered his head in shame.

Dayoung's mother looked at his injured face and then looked back at Yoo Joonghyuk as if she had decided something.

「"I don't know what you're talking about. Cheolsoo-ssi didn't do that. He gave us food."」

「"He gave you food?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk stopped and looked around, suddenly realizing that something was wrong with the atmosphere at the station.

「"What do you mean?"」

「"It's exactly what it sounds like."」

With Dayoung's mother's words, the people behind her began to chime in.

"That's right! You don't even know what he was doing, asshole!"

"Cheolsoo-ssi, come here, you didn't do anything wrong!"

These were all people who we gave food to.

Bang Cheolsoo cried as he was supported by the crowd.

It was then that someone asked.

「"Hey, what do you mean Cheon Inho-ssi is dead?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk took a moment to answer.

"Did you kill him?"

Dayoung's mother asked, and Yoo Joonghyuk didn't answer. Dayoung's mother lamented in a mutter.

「"Why would you do that..... After the first scenario, he was the only one who cared about us, and I thought enough terrible things had already happened....."」

People glared at Yoo Joonghyuk and started chattering.

When Yoo Joonghyuk slowly raised his head to face them, the frightened crowd took a couple steps back.

The Cheoldoo Group filled their spots. Nervously, they each grabbed a pipe and stepped forward to protect the people.

They looked ready to fight if Yoo Joonghyuk charged at them at any moment.

「"Leave!"」

Dayoung shouted, pointing at Yoo, and the crowd chanted in unison.

"Get out of our station now!"

"Bring back Inho-ssi!"

The people shouted.

Yoo Joonghyuk glanced down at the small box of snacks that flew toward him.

Perhaps he had seen the people of this station many times.

He had saved them, killed them, taught them, and rejected them.

And he had given them up.

「Yoo Joonghyuk looked around wordlessly.」

I couldn't tell what he was thinking.

I just prayed that he wouldn't suddenly go crazy and kill everyone.

I don't know how much time passed.

Yoo Joonghyuk slipped his hand into his chest.

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Author's Note

Please save them

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 577 Episode 5. Villain (2)

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The men nervously stepped back, expecting him to pull out a weapon.

But what Yoo Joonghyuk took out was something unexpected.

「"It's highly unlikely."」

He placed two small beads on top of a crumpled snack box.

「"But if a man named Cheon Inho comes, give him these."」

Soon, darkness swallowed Yoo Joonghyuk's black coat, and his shadow disappeared.

I felt a shiver run down my spine.

Suddenly, I wanted to ask the kkoma Kim Dokja next to me, are you feeling the same way?

When I turned around, he was looking at me. His eyes widened in disbelief, and his mouth twitched at me.

You are not supposed to be here.

At that moment, I felt someone grab me by the nape of the neck and pull me away. The screen turned off in front of my eyes, and my consciousness blackened with it.

However, even as my consciousness faded, I vividly remember the last thing I saw.

The kkoma's name tag pinned to his chest. The name tag clearly said so.

Kim Dokja 37.

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"He's awake!"

With a bright phone flash, my vision gradually returned.

The hard floor of the platform. People huddled around, peering at me.

I groaned softly and blinked my eyes open.

"Inho-ssi!"

Kyung Sein tearfully grabbed my shoulder. Beside her, I could see Dansoo ahjussi nodding his head in approval, and Bang Cheolsoo with black eyes.

I groaned and pushed myself up.

"Heewon-ssi is—"

I turned my head and saw Jung Heewon with her eyes tightly closed.

Kyung Sein sobbed and said.

"Heewon-nim carried Inho-ssi on her back. We were going to send a rescue team, but....."

The words I couldn't read were written all over her body. Countless scars on her forearms and scorched knees. Dirt covered her entire body.

Jung Heewon had walked all this way carrying me on her back.

"Don't worry. I gave you first aid. The big wound is almost healed."

Then I realized that I felt fine. It was strange. I was definitely on the verge of death.

As if she noticed my disbelief, Kyung Sein said.

"I fed the two of you 'Elaine Forest's Essence'."

"Ah."

"Yoo Joonghyuk..... gave it to us."

I remembered the scene I saw in my dream earlier. The scene where Yoo Joonghyuk left something on the floor.

I guess it wasn't a dream after all.

But when I thought about it, it was funny. Even though he's the one who hurt Jung Heewon and me, he gave us medicine.

「"Don't forget what you're supposed to do. Don't make me regret hiring a scumbag like you."」

It's probably because he thought I was useful.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is shaking their head.]

I guess my rehabilitation project wasn't a total failure after all.

Bang Cheolsoo seems pretty happy.

Dansoo ahjussi briefly explained what happened after I disappeared. Most of it was what I had seen on the theater's screen.

"What exactly happened on your side? Did you really fight Yoo Joonghyuk?"

I sighed lightly and began to tell Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi what had happened.

From the time I pushed the two of them when I sensed danger, to the time the poisonous rhinoceros broke through the tunnel, to the time Yoo Joonghyuk single-handedly chopped it to pieces.

"Isn't Yoo Joonghyuk kind of...?"

When Yoo Joonghyuk and Jung Heewon fought.

"Wow, Yoo Joonghyuk, I didn't see him that way, but that was cowardly. Honestly, fighting at this time is too unfavorable for Heewon-nim."

To when I got eaten by an ichthyosaur while trying to save Jung Heewon.

"Where have I seen that story before?"

When I signed a contract with Bihyung in the ichthyosaur.

"Mate, you're not Kim Dokja, are you?"

My plan with Jung Heewon to escape from the ichthyosaur.

"I should have been there!"

How Jung Heewon awakened when we were escaping.

"How in the world did that happen....."

"Heewon-nim awakened to what?"

After explaining that much, I felt like Yoo Joonghyuk, who had repeated the same story over and over again.

"Anyway, that's what happened."

"You really struggled. Good job."

"Inho-ssi, you must have gotten a lot of rewards....."

It was only when I saw Kyung Sein asking with shining eyes that I remembered the rewards.

[There are currently 3 unclaimed rewards.]

[You can claim the hidden scenario 'Serpent Slayer' reward.]

[You can claim the hidden scenario 'Commander Slayer' reward.]

[You can claim the constellations' sponsorship reward.]

There really were a lot of unclaimed rewards. But right now, I had more urgent matters to attend to.

"By the way, have you two been in contact with Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"Eh? No. We just saw him from afar."

Apparently, the quick-witted Kyung Sein had used her [Sixth Sense] to avoid an encounter with Yoo Joonghyuk. And Dansoo ahjussi, who was next to him, seemed to have benefited from it as well.

I added, somewhat relieved.

"Good job, you must never contact Yoo Joonghyuk in the future."

Kyung Sein tilted her head at my words, but then nodded as if she understood.

"I see what you mean. I honestly thought I could get away with talking him down, but when I saw him in person I realized he's really crazy. And Kim Dokja is even crazier for barging in on him like that."

Well said.

I don't think these two will do anything unexpected. However, Dansoo ahjussi's expression is strange.

"Is he really such a bad guy?"

"What?"

"I just suddenly had that thought. Even though he did hurt Inho-ssi..... In fact, from Yoo Joonghyuk's point of view, Cheon Inho has always been a villain."

That's fair.

We're seeing Yoo Joonghyuk for the first time, but Yoo Joonghyuk has already met Cheon Inho in the last round. So from his point of view, it might be natural to antagonize me.

"Jiyoon always said, Yoo Joonghyuk's actually a nice guy, and I'll definitely marry him."

Ahjussi said, as if approving of his future son-in-law.

"After all, he gave us the Elaine something, since he's the main character I don't see why he should be treated so badly....."

Common sense tells me not to listen to Dansoo ahjussi.

It would have been the case if this world was the 'Omniscient Reader' that we know.

"Do you remember why we went to the Oksu Station?"

He nodded.

"We didn't meet Yoo Sangah, Lee Gilyoung, Lee Hyunsung or Han Myungoh."

"Oh, come to think of it....."

"Do you know what that means?"

Dansoo ahjussi still looked unsure. But Kyung Sein's expression was hardening a little.

I decided to make it easy for him.

"This is not the 「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」 we know."

"What do you mean?"

"To be more precise, this isn't just any 'Omniscient Reader'. The <Kim Dokja's Company> that we know won't exist here."

Dansoo ahjussi, who had finally realized the situation, opened his mouth. Kyung Sein's eyes widened in shock.

"This is....."

"We're in 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'."

The work-inside-the-work (作中作) of Omniscient Reader and the 3,149 chapters novel read by the protagonist Kim Dokja. We are now in that ruined novel.

Kyung Sein stammered.

"H-How do you know that, Inho-ssi?"

"Because I saw Yoo Joonghyuk's Attribute Window."

"Do you have [Character List] or something like that?"

"Yes. I happened to get it."

Kyung Sein looked at me with a blank face, then at ahjussi, then at Bang Cheolsoo flirting with Dayoung's mother in the distance, then suddenly became contemplative and said.

"Wait, then..... This Yoo Joonghyuk isn't in the third round?"

"Exactly."

In other words, the Yoo Joonghyuk of this world is not the Yoo Joonghyuk we know from 'Omniscient Reader'.

As if thinking of something, Kyung Sein's expression suddenly changed.

"Wait a minute. Now that I think about it, isn't that a good thing? If he had regressed more, he would grow faster, right? In fact, the 1,863th round Yoo Joonghyuk was so strong that he became an outer god."

Dansoo ahjussi chimed in as if he'd remembered something.

"The man who reached the end of the world..... The one who became a god himself..... I remember that too. I'm pretty sure Jiyoon had that glued on the front of her desk. The Sneaky Schemer....."

"Secretive Plotter. Anyway, Inho-ssi. Isn't it too early to assume the worst yet?"

Certainly, the Yoo Joonghyuk of 'Ways of Survival' could have been stronger than the Yoo Joonghyuk of the original.

In fact, after 1,863 regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk becomes strong enough to reach the 'Final Wall' alone.

Even if he didn't necessarily pass 1,863 rounds, Yoo Joonghyuk's combat power becomes exponentially stronger in the second half.

The problem is.

"That's on the second half of his regressions."

It would have been better if it was the second half, or even the last part.

In the main novel, there is also a scene where Kim Dokja enslaves Yoo Joonghyuk in the 1,863rd round.

While I wouldn't have been able to feed him soil like Kim Dokja, I would have tried something similar.

But in this round, there was no chance of that.

It was something I could say because I met him face to face.

"This round doesn't work in our favor, because this round's Yoo Joonghyuk is the worst Yoo Joonghyuk ever."

"The worst Yoo Joonghyuk? How many times has he regressed?"

Throughout the entirety of 「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」, there is one Yoo Joonghyuk who makes everyone shiver.

If you possess someone in 'Ways of Survival', you should never get close to him, no matter what.

I remembered the lines of Shin Yooseung, who came as a disaster in the third round.

「"You, who wanted to be acknowledged by Yoo Joonghyuk, died in the sea you loved so much. You were horribly slaughtered by the Japanese who hated your sponsor..... Do you know what Yoo Joonghyuk said after losing you?"」

"In the future, sea battles will be a bit difficult."

Kyung Sein's eyes widened at my words.

I continued.

「"You saved the lives of countless people and protected Yoo Joonghyuk to the end. Then you were hit with the breath of the iron blood dragon and scattered into a handful of ashes. Do you know what Yoo Joonghyuk said then?"」

"I lost a bad shield."

Those lines were Yoo Joonghyuk's dark story, one of the best in 'Ways of Survival'.

Finally realizing what I was talking about, Kyung Sein's lips trembled.

"It's not true, is it, Inho-ssi? Please, please tell me it's not."

Perhaps, only in this world line, Yoo Joonghyuk could never be said to be a better man than Cheon Inho.

A man who sacrificed all his colleagues, even turned them into disasters, just to end this <Star Stream>.

「What Yoo Joonghyuk did was worse than murder. Thousands of years. This period of time was enough to make a person collapse and their ego to wear down. Shin Yooseung

endured all that time and finally became a 'disaster'.」

I blinked slowly, recalling the regression turn number I had seen on Yoo Joonghyuk.

"This world's Yoo Joonghyuk is the '41st round'."

The Yoo Joonghyuk of this world is the worst villain in the universe, one who exterminated all his colleagues.

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Author's Note

So scary

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 578 Episode 5. Villain (3)

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After realizing that this world was the '41st round' of Ways of Survival, Kyung Sein slowly dropped to the ground and began to do planks.

Dansoo ahjussi was speechless for a while, as if he hadn't realized what was happening yet.

I didn't stop them and waited for a while.

I could hear Kyung Sein counting.

"Nine, ten, eleven....."

In the distance, I saw Bang Cheolsoo talking to Dayoung's mother.

"Cheolsoo-ssi, how come you're so fearless and brave?"

"Haha, the life I've lived is a little different than most people."

Suddenly, I wanted to slap Bang Cheolsoo on the back of the head.

"Thirty-eight, thirty-nine, forty..... Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"What do we do now?"

Apparently, no amount of planking could give her an answer, because she collapsed to the floor.

I helped her to her feet.

"It's okay, we have Dansoo ahjussi and Sein-ssi. And Sein-ssi said she'd read Omniscient Reader's Encyclopedia or something like that ten times."

"What's the point of reading that? This is not Omniscient Reader, it's Ways of Survival. The 41st round is barely mentioned in the novel. The only thing that is mentioned is....."

I know. It's all about how bad Yoo Joonghyuk was.

Just because this world is the 41st round, some of the methods Kim Dokja used are now obsolete.

"Still, we can't give up yet. It's still early in the scenario."

"But it's the 41st round! Yoo Joonghyuk is a scumbag!"

Dansoo ahjussi, who finally realized the seriousness of the situation, muttered his daughter's name.

Suddenly, memories of the days when I was writing my manuscript came back to me.

When I was writing the 'Disaster of Floods' episode, in which the Shin Yooseung from the 41st round was a disaster, I received a letter from a reader at the management office.

Yoo Joonghyuk can't be such a bad guy. Honestly, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk is a plot hole, please fix it immediately.

It was a letter that said something like that.

At the time, I thought, 'Who are you, asshole?' But now that I think about it, the reader was right.

I should have just fixed it then.

"He'll become trashier and trashier, but maybe he's not irredeemable yet. Even in Omniscient Reader, Yoo Joonghyuk was a psychopath at first. He changed later on, so maybe there's a chance for him here."

You can't rewrite people, but you can rewrite characters.

It's funny that I'm defending a guy who tried to kill me, but I'm not going to lose hope yet.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is looking at you.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says they're not sure what you are talking about, but the man in the black coat looks like a bad guy.]

As long as you carry out the scenarios, you will continue to run into Yoo Joonghyuk. You can't just keep avoiding him every time.

After all, you'll need his help to clear the final chapter.

Especially if this is 'Ways of Survival' instead of 'Omniscient Reader'.

"If possible, I'll be the one to contact Yoo Joonghyuk from now on. You should avoid him no matter what."

"Will you be alright?"

"After all, he gave me the 'Elaine Forest Essence'."

"Isn't that just to take advantage of Inho-ssi?"

"That's what I think, too, so that's good, because he won't kill me right away if I'm worth using."

I'm sure he'd left something like that because he still has expectations for me.

Besides, I didn't tell them, but there were still secrets in this '41st round' that I didn't know about.

For example, there's some kind of deal between Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk from the previous round.

There's no need to think about it right now. We'll just have to find out slowly from now on.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' picks his nose and asks how long the filter will be up.]

Please be patient with us, constellations-nim.

We're talking about something important.

"Don't be discouraged, just do what you can. Our pace isn't bad either. Heewon-ssi has awakened, Dansoo ahjussi knows how to tame bugs, Sein-ssi has [Average Correction], and Sein-ssi, you're putting all your coins on physique, right?"

"Yes. Of course, but....."

I knew it.

As expected from the soul of a muscular man.

If Kyung Sein could play the tanker role, the party now had a basic formation of damage dealer-support-tanker.

So what's my position?

"I've got Cheon Inho who can carry the eloquence role, so we're not that far behind <Kim Dokja's Company>."

Kyung Sein laughed weakly at my joke.

Suddenly, Dansoo ahjussi, who was already in high spirits, nodded his head.

"Inho-ssi is right."

"You recovered quickly."

"This is nothing."

"You're not from a different world than ours, are you?"

"Jiyoon will be disappointed if I get frustrated over this."

Perhaps the most frustrated person here is Dansoo ahjussi.

He's not even a devoted reader of Omniscient Reader, he's just a guy who ended up possessing someone in the novel because of his daughter.....

I became a little curious about what kind of life Dansoo ahjussi had that led him to possess someone here.

"Let's go get the hidden piece first. We were lucky enough to start at Geumho Station, so we have an advantage over everyone else."

"Ah! Do you mean, to get 'that'.....?"

"Yep. Let's go get it."

At Geumho Station, there is a representative hidden piece that Kim Dokja gets.

The star relic, 'Unbroken Faith'.

In order to get it, you must go to the 'Edge of Darkness' of Geumho Station and enter the 'Ground Rat's Treasure Trove'.

Dansoo ahjussi's expression was dark.

"If that's the case, we'd better hurry."

"Oh, right. Actually....."

Kyung Sein said as she jumped to her feet.

"There are people who have already set out that way."

No, you should have told me that first, guys.

---

We quickly finished our preparations and stood in the tunnel leading to the Yaksu Station.

I thought about waiting for Jung Heewon to wake up, but I was impatient that there were people who had already left ahead of us.

"Don't worry about Heewon-ssi and go."

When Dayoung's mother opened her mouth as if to leave it to her, Bang Cheolsoo thumped his chest and spoke up.

"I'll protect Geumho Station!"

Dayoung's mother nodded reliably and looked at Bang Cheolsoo.

I stared at the two figures for a moment, a weird atmosphere beginning to form. Something had definitely changed, but I didn't know if it was for the better.

"Let's go."

We stepped into the tunnel, and in an instant, the voices grew quieter, followed by another deep darkness.

This time, it was Kyung Sein who spoke up first.

"It's not fair to wake up Heewon-nim and come back again, is it?"

"You said you fed her Elaine Forest Essence, so she won't wake up even if you try."

"But we don't even have a DPS[1] now..... Isn't it dangerous?"

[NOTE 1]

"We don't have much time left. If they passed through here twenty minutes ago, they might have already entered the 'Edge of Darkness.'"

Honestly, I didn't expect anyone to go first. Kim Dokja in the original novel was still in the middle of his hidden scenario.

"How many people went first?"

"Two, a man and a woman. They came down from upstairs all of a sudden....."

"Were they readers?"

Actually, this was a question to get her thinking.

She answered immediately.

"I don't know, but I guess so, because the timing doesn't allow for any characters to pass by here. I didn't get a good look at them because they were going too fast on their bikes, but....."

A bike? This early on?

"But Inho-ssi, you do know that there's a boss monster at the 'Edge of Darkness', right?"

"Yes. I know."

For reference, there is an initial boss monster in the 'Edge of Darkness', the 'Dark Keeper'.

Fortunately, there was a way to deal with it in Omniscient Reader.

Kyung Sein asked, her eyes shining with anticipation.

"Did you happen to buy [Purest Sword Force] or the 'Broken Faith'?"

I shook my head.

[Purest Sword Force] was sold out, and from what I could gather through Bihyung, there were no sellers for Broken Faith, only a long waiting list.

-Why is everyone getting that crappy item? Is there some kind of patch I don't know about?

Kyung Sein's expression darkened.

"Then we won't be able to catch the 'Dark Keeper'? Even in the original, Kim Dokja barely beat it with the combo of [Purest Sword Force] and 'Broken Faith'."

"I'll think about it as we go."

"If you don't have 'Broken Faith', you can't make 'Unbroken Faith'....."

"First of all, we should get the random item box."

There is a 'random item box' in the Ground Rat's Treasure Trove, which is guarded by the 'Dark Keeper', that allows you to 'upgrade items' in the first use.

Kim Dokja used the box to upgrade his 'Broken Faith' to 'Unbroken Faith'.

Kyung Sein shook her head.

"Well, you can get 'Broken Faith' later. Do you remember all the boss patterns?"

"Yeah."

The problem is the physique to perform the pattern.

I opened the rewards messages I'd been putting off.

[There are currently 3 unclaimed rewards.]

I hit the collect button one by one.

[You have claimed the reward for the hidden scenario 'Serpent Slayer'].

[The scenario was cleared early due to the intervention of other sea species.]

[You have received part of the scenario's reward.]

[2,000 coins have been earned.]

Unfortunately, I only received half of the reward because the final hit was stolen by the Sea Commander. The next reward, however, was more than enough to make up for the disappointment.

[The incarnation you awakened, 'Jung Heewon', hunted the 'Sea Commander'.]

[The incarnation 'Jung Heewon' succeeded in looting the rewards of the hidden scenario —'Commander Slayer' that someone was performing.]

[A portion of the looted reward is attributed to you.]

[4,000 coins have been earned.]

[2,000 additional coins have been earned for your first looting reward.]

Looting rewards?

Wait a minute.

Does it mean there was an incarnation hunting the 'Sea Commander'?

My head was spinning.

According to the main story of Omniscient Reader, it was Kim Dokja who hunted down the 'Sea Commander' and earned the reward.

Since there will most likely not be a Kim Dokja in this round, it must be a regular reader who read Omniscient Reader.

What happened to that reader?

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' chuckles.]

I feel sorry for that reader, but 6,000 coins for the looting was a great harvest anyway.

And that wasn't the only reward.

[You have claimed the constellations' sponsorship rewards.]

[6,800 coins have been sponsored.]

Jung Heewon's awakening scene was quite popular on the <Star Stream>, and we received a significant amount of sponsorships for such an early stage.

Prisoner of the Golden Headband, Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, and the nice animal constellations donated coins.

[14,800 coins have been earned in total.]

[Coins Possessed: 17,100 C]

I'm rich now.

If I were Kim Dokja, I'd be saving this like it was my last dollar.

But I'm different.

---

rlaehrwk37: Anyone else been stupidly robbed of their rewards?

.....

.....

rlaehrwk37: No?

rlaehrwk49: So what?

---

Author's Note

So what what?

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

Note [1]: DPS: damage dealer.

# 579 Episode 5. Villain (4)

---

[4,000 coins have been invested into 'Strength'.]

[Strength Lv.10 → Strength Lv.20]

[Your strength level has increased significantly!]

[Passing Dokkaebis will be scared away by your strength.]

First of all, my strength should be high.

[5,800 coins have been invested into 'Agility'.]

[Agility Lv.4 → Agility Lv.20]

[Your agility level has increased significantly!]

[Your agility will make even a passing elf look back.]

I have two left feet, so I'll use my high agility to dodge.

[3,800 coins have been invested into 'Physique'.]

[Physique Lv.4 → Physique Lv.15]

I need this much physique.

[1,800 coins have been invested into 'Magic Power'.]

[Magic Power Lv.4 → Magic Power Lv.10]

Luckily, Magic Power had a birth stat of 4, so I could save some coins.

[A total of 15,400 coins have been spent.]

[Coins Possessed: 1,700 C]

I was down to my last coin, but I had no regrets. You need to increase your stats early on.

It wasn't until I met Yoo Joonghyuk that I realized this.

I don't have any S-class skills, so when I meet a monster like Yoo Joonghyuk, I have to support my body to withstand even one blow.

[You are the third incarnation of this scenario to break through Strength level 20.]

[300 coins have been acquired as a reward.]

[You are the third incarnation of this scenario to break through Agility level 20.]

[300 coins have been acquired as a reward.]

Despite hitting Strength and Agility level 20 so quickly, there was someone faster than me.

Probably other readers. What a great bunch of guys.

Grrrrr.

Soon, I began to hear the cries of the ground rats. We had finally entered a densely populated area.

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi, who were beside me, started to move nervously.

"You two together!"

As if the two of them had just planned a formation, the tanker Kyung Sein stepped forward, and Dansoo ahjussi followed behind her, sloppily drawing his sword.

Kyung Sein looked at me with a serious expression and asked.

"There's also the 'three together' formation!"

"That..... you two look good together."

"In front! There are seven!"

Kyung Sein let out a roaring shout and ran forward, only to be gnawed to pieces.

A weak body would be split into two in an instant.

"Uaaak! It hurts! It hurts! Help me!"

I wondered how much physique she had. Despite being bitten here and there by the ground rats, Kyung Sein was unharmed.

Then Dansoo ahjussi began do some strange movements.

"Hang in there, hee-job!"

Judging by the flashy movements, it was clear that if I left them to their own devices, they wouldn't catch a single ground rat.

I pulled out the thorns I'd bought and lightly poked the nearest ground rat.

Its head exploded like a ripe tomato.

Indeed, Strength level 20 was something else. I started stabbing their heads one by one.

Pow! Pow! Pow! Pow!

In no time at all, I had cleared out five of them, and when I turned around, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi had barely cleared out one each.

When Kyung Sein realized that there were no more ground rats around us, she looked at me in disbelief and asked.

"Inho-ssi, were you actually strong?"

"Of course."

"I knew it, I knew it!"

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' points his finger, saying you're too proud of yourself for a power you gained from coins.]

I'm so excited because it's the first time I've used it.

After that, we encountered mischiefs of ground rats a few times, but with my strength and agility exceeding 20, the ground rats were no longer opponents for me.

"Wow, Inho-ssi, you're awesome."

"Heh, I feel strong."

This is how the protagonist feels.

As we were advancing, beating ground rats one by one, I couldn't help but laugh out loud.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' says this is the only time you can play like this.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says that the early stages of growth are the most fun.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' agrees that it is.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' blinks nostalgically.]

Missing it.....

Well, I'm sure the other constellations grew up catching ground rats at first.

That thought reminded me of Kim Dokja again.

"Suddenly, I really respect Kim Dokja."

He must have crossed the same Yaksu Station tunnel as us.

At a much lower level than me.

He wasn't afraid, he didn't back down, and he believed in what he read.

Can I believe in what I write?

Kyung Sein asked.

"There will be no Kim Dokja in this world line, right?"

"Because this is 'Ways of Survival'."

As I answered, a memory flashed through my mind.

I remembered the Kim Dokja in my dream. One of them was really vague, and the other was just a kkoma...

Is there really no Kim Dokja in this world?

"But maybe he's looking at us from up there, just like we did."

The ceiling of the dark tunnel was as dark as a starless night sky.

Kyung Sein looked up for a moment, then suddenly waved her hand and called out.

"Kim Dokja! Kim Dokja!"

She shouted it several times.

Naturally, there was no answer from thin air, but Kyung Sein seemed much happier.

"Kim Dokja....."

If Kim Dokja is really seeing this world, our positions are now reversed.

I wondered if I could reach the end of the scenarios like him.

I wasn't sure. But there's Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi.

There will be other readers.

It's hard for one person, but if we all work together, it might be possible.

If it's as Han Sooyoung said, they're also 'Kim Dokja's fragments'.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' nods.]

I wonder what form this 'filtering' takes for the constellations.

It was then that something like starlight flickered across the darkness.

"Huh?"

I rushed over to it and saw a flashlight on the floor. Someone had been here before.

And beside it.

"Over here."

We looked down into pitch black cave, which opened up beneath our feet.

"I think I found it."

It was the 'Edge of Darkness'.

---

We stepped into the darkness, hand in hand.

It was definitely a passage leading down, but the moment we entered it, gravity magically shifted toward the wall.

It was as described in the Omniscient Reader.

In this space filled with black ether, light loses its meaning. In the darkness, you can't see a thing, and you have to rely on your senses to move forward.

Leading the way was Dansoo ahjussi, who had [Diverse Communication].

"This way."

Dansoo ahjussi sounded encouraged, as if he finally realized he had an important role to play.

Kyung Sein spoke up as if bored.

"Ahjussi."

"Yes."

"How old are you?"

"I'll be 53 this year."

"You mean your original age?"

"Yes."

"You can talk to us comfortably[1]. Right, Inho-ssi?"

[NOTE 1]

"Yes. Make yourself comfortable."

I could feel him shaking his head in the darkness.

"I'm comfortable with honorifics."

I didn't think it was respectful of us to do.

Anyway, he was a very polite man.

"May I ask what you used to do for work?"

He seemed to think about my question for a moment.

"Before I came here, I was just unemployed."

I wondered if I shouldn't have asked, but he continued immediately.

"I was in the hospital."

Hospital. The moment he said the word, his hand in mine became strangely strong.

"Maybe that's why this world feels more like an opportunity to me."

Opportunity.

I knew what he meant, but I thought it would be rude to ask more.

This time, ahjussi asked.

"Why do you think we're here?"

It was the first question that anyone who came to this world would ask themselves.

Kyung Sein was the first to answer.

"Maybe we're here to experience it, too."

His tone was playful, but it was also a possibility that couldn't be ruled out.

"What do you think, Inho-ssi?"

I thought for a moment before answering.

"Maybe they need someone to complete this story."

"Oh..... I hadn't thought of something that profound. So, was it 'Ways of Survival' that summoned us?"

"I don't know about that."

"Maybe it was <Kim Dokja's Company>. Kim Dokja? Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"Yoo Joonghyuk, ahjussi."

I wonder who called us here.

I thought it was <Kim Dokja's Company> at first, but now I'm not sure.

I wonder if <Kim Dokja's Company> would bring their readers to this dangerous place for any reason.

"Could it be Han Sooyoung? She's the writer of Omniscient Reader after all."

The moment I heard Kyung Sein's words, I felt a strange feeling.

As expected, readers also think that Han Sooyoung is the 'writer' of this world.

Even I felt a little miserable that I didn't have any objections to that fact.

When I think about it, 'Omniscient Reader' was quite an unusual novel.

Originally, I had never thought of such a story before. But the story came to me one day out of the blue.

It was as if someone had hit me in the back of the head.

Kyung Sein continued.

"Of course, our world line's former writer of Omniscient Reader is a different person....."

My palms suddenly felt sweaty. I was glad it was pitch black.

"I don't know what happened to our writer. Maybe he got possessed along with us, or maybe he's already dead because he's always writing announcements saying that he's sick. I even sent him a note on how to stretch the other day."

He's holding your hand right now.

"Shh. There's someone in front of us."

We shut up at ahjussi's words.

The black ether around us visibly decreased, and we gradually began to see a little further ahead.

It meant we were approaching the 'Dark Root', the core of the 'Edge of Darkness'.

"Someone's fighting."

We heard the faint sound of a weapon.

[You have entered the 'Ground Rat's Treasure Trove'.]

[Someone is performing a sub scenario.]

The bodies of a number of ground rats littered the floor. They were cut from head to stomach with a single sword, so it's clear that this person was very good.

As I got closer, I saw a dark fire(暗火) burning in the darkness. A somber box under the light of the dark fire.

It was the 'random item box' we were looking for.

Standing in front of it was, as expected, the Dark Keeper.

The battle was already well underway, and the enraged Dark Keeper was casting tentacle patterns in a frenzy.

"Kallituu!"

There was a short person fighting the Dark Keeper.

Kyung Sein whispered.

"That's the one I saw earlier, on the bike."

A woman with a light blue bob and sunglasses was engaged in a breathtaking battle.

She was dodging the tentacles with uncanny fluidity, delivering blow after blow. It was as if she'd typed in her fighting commands and then executed them.

Even more shocking was the blue-white ether that flowed faintly from her steel fist.

Dedicated Sword Force (罡氣功).

It sounded familiar.

Kyung Sein muttered under her breath.

"That's it, right?"

"I think so."

I looked again, sure enough.

She was using Kim Dokja's [Purest Sword Force].

I wondered who the hell had robbed that item, but it must have been her.

The Purest Sword Force is the Purest Sword Force, but I was surprised that she could fight like that against the Dark Keeper.

What on earth did she do to be able to grow so rapidly from the beginning?

I wondered who she was.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

[The information of this person can't be read in 'Character List'.]

[This person is a 'character' but not a 'character'.]

That woman is definitely a 'reader'.

Maybe she's one of the 'pros' Kyung Sein mentioned.

[Using 'Readers' Comments List' on this person.]

I immediately checked the reader's information.

ID: ansgkrthsu64

Platform: Sirius

Total Comments: 0

Reader Level: 21

Number of Reads: 0

* This reader didn't write comments, so there are no comments to view.

I was dazed for a moment.

0 complete reads.

That means she's never read Omniscient Reader.

And yet she can fight like that?

[The reader has no record of having read 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.]

[Additional information about the target has been updated.]

[Some of the 'List Information' is corrected.]

When I checked again, some of the information had changed.

Number of Reads: 0 times (12.8 times)

Suddenly, I saw 12.8 times in parentheses. What the hell?

It was at that moment that I felt a cold sensation in the back of my head.

Something pointy touched the back of my neck.

"All three of you, don't move. If any of you move, I'll kill him."

I felt goosebumps. I didn't notice him at all.

"Drop your weapons to the ground and slowly put your hands over your heads."

Since I didn't know my opponent's strength level or skill information, it was best to do as I was told.

If he was good enough at stealth to get behind us now, he could attack us at any moment.

Spot!

That's when the tide turned in the melee up ahead. The woman who had been dodging the tentacles with her ghostly movements received a cut on her forearm for the first time.

I opened my mouth.

"We can help. We're not here to be enemies."

"We don't need help."

"Don't be greedy. You know you can't catch it on your own."

"We two are enough."

The man spoke to the woman in a calm voice.

"Yerin, don't panic, fight. The pattern is starting again."

The man's following words surprised me.

"The pattern starts at the upper right. After that, there will be one at the bottom, and then you'll have to feed him a series of consecutive strikes."

This was clearly how Kim Dokja had beaten the 'Dark Keeper' in 'Omniscient Reader'.

He remembered it all?

"Cut off all the tentacles. Then finish it."

Blue-white ether surged from the woman's fist. It was meant to gather energy and end it in a single blow.

But it was a clear mistake.

I didn't write about it in detail in Omniscient Reader, but the Dark Keeper had one final hidden pattern.

The last pattern that Ji Eunyu edited out because she thought the battle scene was getting too long.

I sucked in a breath and shouted at the top of my lungs.

"Dodge! There's one more! Last one is from the floor!"

As soon as I finished speaking, a tentacle shot out from the floor.

She froze for a moment, but managed to dodge the tentacle before delivering the final blow.

Kuaaaaaah!

The now incapacitated Dark Keeper fell to his knees and slumped to the ground.

The woman who had just spotted us looked over. I couldn't see her eyes through her sunglasses, but I could tell she was surprised.

A man's voice came from behind me.

"Turn around slowly."

We slowly turned around with our hands on our heads.

As soon as we turned around, we saw the man holding the 'Stone Hog's Pointed Thorn'.

He was obviously an extra because he didn't look familiar, but I was impressed that he had a pretty handsome face.

To put it in Ways of Survival terms, it was enough to maybe poke Yoo Joonghyuk's face with a finger. I immediately activated my skill.

[Using 'Readers' Comments List' on this person.]

| |
|---|
| ID: killer_king |

Platform: Sirius, Paper books

Total Comments: 491

Reader Level: 99

Number of Reads: 99.8

* You can use coins to view the comments written by this reader.

* Number of comments currently available for free: 3.

I doubted my eyes.

99.8 complete reads.

This..... Surely there wasn't an error?

The man glaring at me with a strange look in his eyes suddenly said something strange.

"7942."

---

Author's Note

In fact, we can see our reader's level.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

Note [1]: They mean casually, without honorifics.

# 580 Episode 5. Villain (5)

---

7942? What's that?

"7942."

The man said it again.

I wondered if it was some sort of reader-defined code word.

I should answer correctly.

"Between friends!"

Dansoo ahjussi suddenly exclaimed. He spoke with the speed of a scholarship quiz.

He turned to me and muttered in a half-whisper.

"My mate doesn't know, but that means 'between friends' these days. It sounds like he's happy to see you."

But no matter how I looked at it, those were not friendly eyes.

The thorn in the man's hand slowly pointed at Dansoo ahjussi. The man's expression turned cold, and a breathless confrontation ensued.

"9158!"

Kyung Sein shouted fitfully.

The thorn stopped in midair.

"You're a member of the Seven Apostles, right?"

Kyung Sein's expression was somehow flushed as she said that.

The man who retracted the thorn asked.

"Who are you?"

---

After using 'Readers' Comments List' a few times, I slowly realized the generation pattern of the readers' ID.

For example, Dansoo ahjussi's ID, wldbsdldkQk80, when typed on a QWERTY keyboard using the Korean layout, looks like this:

wldbsdldkQk80 = Jiyoon's dad 80

We can convert alsdn0905, Kyung Sein's ID, similarly:

alsdn0905 = Minwoo0905 (presumably her real name).

Both of them were perfect if they wanted their personal information to be leaked.

But the two new people I met were different.

First, there was this guy.

killer_king[1] = killer_king

[NOTE 1]

Killer King. Aside from the fact that it's a combination of two cool words, it's a pretty uninformative ID.

On the other hand, the woman over there lighting the 'Magic Power Stove' was a little different.

ansgkrthsu64 = LiteratureGirl64

I didn't recognize her nickname, but it was clear that she was a book lover.

LiteraryGirl64 placed the freshly caught ground rat meat on the Magic Power Stove and began roasting it with medicine.

"Sit down for now."

Killer King commanded us confidently, then sat down himself.

He hesitated a moment, then added some words.

"I guess it doesn't matter if I speak informally. This isn't 'real life' anyway."

"This is real too."

"No, this is a 'new world' dominated by 'new laws'."

If that is the mindset of a reader who has read Omniscient Reader 99.8 times, I can only respect it.

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi didn't seem to disagree.

We are all adults.

"Are all three of you readers?"

"Yes, as you can see."

"How do you know the password of the Apostles?"

The Seven Apostles. I had heard the name of the community from Kyung Sein before.

She replied.

"I was a member of the community, though I was rarely active."

"Nickname?"

"Judge Heewon."

After a moment of thought, Killer King asked.

"Are you the guy who used to post pictures of his abs on the message boards all the time?"

"Ah! You remember."

"It'd be strange if I didn't remember. You've been doing the same thing every day for two years."

"Haha, yeah, I did."

"It's a shame you don't have abs to show off."

Kyung Sein looked down at her tiny body and chuckled.

"Still, it's fun to start anew. And here, you just level up your stats and your body improves on its own."

"It's a convenient world."

"Now I'd like to hear about you."

"I'm Killer King."

Kyung Sein's mouth dropped open.

"Killer King? Are you really the Killer King?"

Killer King nodded, and Kyung Sein shuddered.

I asked in a whisper.

"Is he famous?"

"Of course he is. There's no one who doesn't know his nickname."

I don't know, but that Killer King seemed to be very important in that world.

"Killer King-nim is the Second Apostle of the Seven Apostles."

Since they were the Seven Apostles, it must have a total of seven leaders.

This means that the Killer King in front of me is the second of them...

Wait. So there's someone who's read more than him?

As if reading my mind, Kyung Sein whispered.

"Rumor has it that the First Apostle has read Omniscient Reader over 100 times."

Killer King, who had overheard the conversation, stepped in.

"It's not 'Omniscient Reader', it's the 'Book of Revelation'. I see you've already forgotten the rules of the Seven Apostles."

"Oh, yes, I did. I'm sorry."

"And I was about to reach the 100 readings myself."

"Stop talking about pathetic things and eat."

Everyone turned around at the sound of her voice. LiteraryGirl64, who had been silent for a long time, opened her mouth for the first time.

Perhaps because of the sudden attention, LiteraryGirl64 lowered her head blushing and looked down at the stove.

Kyung Sein asked Killer King.

"Is she also an 'Apostle'?"

Killer King picked up a skewer of ground rat and said.

"She's just my younger sibling."

"Ah, so your sister has read the Book of Revelation."

"No, I haven't."

"What? And yet you ended up in Omniscient Reader?"

At that, LiteraryGirl64 glared at Killer King.

Killer King coughed lightly and replied.

"I told her about the Book of Revelation a few times."

"How many times?"

"......Quite a few times."

Suddenly, I understood the meaning of (12.8 times) in LiteraryGirl64's information list.

She shook her head as if she was bored, and handed us each a skewer of ground rat.

As I was about to take the skewer, Literature Girl 64 glanced in my direction. When I looked back at her, she bowed her head and mumbled something.

I wasn't sure, but she seemed to be thanking me.

I think she was thanking me for telling her the attack pattern earlier.

"What?"

She just smiled and handed me the skewer.

I'm touched. This is completely normal.

It was painful to think that the one who didn't read Omniscient Reader was the most normal.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' smacks his lips.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' gulps down his saliva.]

I was really hungry, and the sight of the golden brown meat in front of me was hard to resist.

Kyung Sein asked.

"May I eat it?"

"Of course."

"Thanks for the meal."

We started tearing into the meat without anyone stopping us.

When you're eating something really good, there's a natural silence. No one said a word, but we were all thinking the same thing.

「This is really good.」

The meat that existed only in text has become real. The seasoning that his younger sister made was just right.

"Ha, it's really good."

"You're very skillful."

Only after barely tearing off one leg piece by piece did Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi express their admiration at the same time.

LiteraryGirl64 smiled silently.

Killer King also shook his head as if the meat wasn't bad.

"Killer King-nim. I'm actually a real fan of yours. I also remember the comment war you had with the members of the Misreading Association for three days and four nights."

"You remember that useless stuff."

"Seriously, I can't tell you how lucky I am to see you here. I've almost died several times, but you've read the Book of Revelation 99 ti—"

"Almost 100 times."

"I never thought I'd meet the Killer King who read it almost 100 times....."

"Why are you glad you met me?"

"What? It's you we're talking about."

"I could be a bad guy."

Kyung Sein's eyes widened.

"Don't say that. No one who has read the Book of Revelation all the way through is a bad person."

I was speechless for a moment.

Even more surprising was Killer King's response.

"Not everyone who reads it is a good human being."

He said so seriously, immersed in a strange sense of sorrow. It would have been a bit cool if his name wasn't Killer King.

Kyung Sein was speechless, while Dansoo ahjussi looked lethargic, perhaps because he was full.

Since no one else spoke up, I had to point it out.

"By the way, your way of speaking is strangely similar to someone's."

"No."

"You must like Yoo Joonghyuk."

LiteraryGirl64, who was next to me, let out a dry chuckle.

Killer King looked at me and asked.

"You hardly ate the meat."

"I'm a slow eater."

"What's your nickname?"

"Oh, he's not an Apostle. He doesn't join any comms."

Killer King's eyes narrowed at Kyung Sein's comment.

"How many times have you read the Book of Revelation?"

"I don't remember, but I must have read it more than 10 times."

[Someone has used 'Lie Detection'.]

Wow, he already had [Lie Detection]?

[The other person has confirmed that the statement is true.]

If I've read it 100 times it's also more than 10 times.

"I see. You'll be an intermediate apostle by 10 times."

I was surprised to see Killer King looking at me in pure amazement.

I didn't realize there were grades for apostles.

"I'm flattered."

"How did you know about the last pattern of the 'Dark Keeper'? That doesn't even appear in the Book of Revelation."

"It just came to me."

[The other person has confirmed that the statement is true.]

Killer King had a questioning look on his face.

"You must have a foresight skill."

"Well, I do have the ability to find out hidden information."

I have notes that only I know about, so this wasn't a lie.

[The other person has confirmed that the statement is true.]

Killer King nodded and said.

"Interesting."

A moment of silence.

I spat the bite of skewer I'd taken onto the floor and stood up slowly.

"I'm not that interesting."

At the same time, Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein fell sideways.

I glared at the two people in front of me, holding the spike in my right hand.

Killer King held the spike like me, ready for battle. And beside him, I could see LiteraryGirl64, her head down. Killer King said.

"They're not dead, just asleep."

If it's a sleeping potion you can get early on, it's probably the stem of yanaspleta.

I don't know how they got it, but they were prepared.

"Why did you do this?"

"I have two reasons."

Killer King looked at the 'Dark Keeper' lying in the distance.

"One. You were going to attack us."

"We weren't."

"Two. I smell blood on you."

"That's because we caught a lot of ground rats."

"The smell of human blood."

I paused for the first time.

"Even if you know the contents of the Book of Revelation, you are, at your core, an ordinary human being. Few humans can kill their own kind without hesitation because they're suddenly in a novel."

"True, but if you want to protect yourself, you have to fight."

"The average reader has a pattern. If you've been lucky enough to find a bug and kill it, you wouldn't have killed anyone yet, but if you had to kill someone, you would have killed one. But."

Upon closer inspection, one of Killer King's eyes shone with an unnerving dark red color.

I knew what that skill was.

"You have killed at least ten human beings."

It is the stigma of an archangel who can read the sins of others.

"Anything else to say? Murderer."

It seems that 'Killer King''s sponsor is 'Archangel Jophiel'.

Author's Note

Thank you.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: It was written in English in the original.

# 581 Episode 5. Villain (6)

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This was how a criminal caught in an absurd place felt.

I was a little resentful of Dansoo ahjussi, who had passed out, oblivious to my anxiety. If he had picked Jophiel back then, none of this would have happened.

I turned to the oncoming Killer King and said,

"Wait a minute. Listen to me. You asked me if I had anything left to say."

"I didn't say I'd listen. I wasn't interested in hearing your excuses for slaughtering a dozen people in the first place."

Apparently, [Eye of Sin] had recorded the nineteen people I killed via incitement as a 'sin'.

It was unfair.

I wanted to tell them everything.

I was actually the one who wrote Omniscient Reader, and the people I killed were the ones who would later become the evil 'Life's Teachings' cult.

"You look upset. You must think your killing was justified because that's how this world works."

In a sense, it was the truth, so I had nothing to say.

"The Misreading Association was just like you."

"Misreading Association?"

Killer King looked wordlessly in his sister's direction, and LiteraryGirl64 shook her head stubbornly. It seemed like she didn't want to fight me.

"Yerin, we have to kill him now. The Eye of Sin isn't wrong, he's dangerous."

"....."

"We'll do it like we did with the Misreading Association guys, I'll finish him off."

The moment I heard those words, the back of my head tingled.

"Wait."

Suddenly, an unpleasant sensation crawled up my spine.

"Did you kill a 'real person'?"

"Are there real people and fake ones?"

"You know what I mean. Did you kill other readers?"

「"No one who has read the Book of Revelation all the way through is a bad person."」

I didn't entirely disagree with Kyung Sein. There were certainly good and bad people among the readers.

But whether they were good or bad, there was a bond shared only by those who had read the story.

I wanted to believe that there was a promise, at least between fellow 'readers', that we wouldn't turn a blind eye to anyone who knew the tragedy of this world.

"The 'Misreading Association' deserves to die."

However, right in front of me, there was a reader who disagreed.

A reader who had read this story 99 times, a reader who probably understood this world better than anyone.

I told him.

"If you die here, you're really dead."

"Good. They were sociopaths to begin with."

With those words, I was convinced. This Killer King was out of his mind.

If I let him go, he would ruin the whole scenario, not to mention endanger the other readers.

But could I win against them?

As if Killer King wasn't bad enough, LiteraryGirl64 over there was a monster who could deal with the Dark Keeper alone.

It was then that the surroundings began to turn colorless.

「Time stopped.」

These were the signs of the skill '■■'.

However, I couldn't see anyone performing any 'unexpected behavior'.

Why then?

[Your skill has reached a certain level.]

The reason was quickly apparent.

[Your exclusive skill '■■' is blossoming!]

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '■■' have been relaxed.]

[The skill will be urgently triggered when one or more of the following conditions are met.]

| |
|---|
| 1. A specific character attempts an 'unexpected behavior'. |

2. An important 'event' branch occurs (limited to 3 times per day).

Perhaps because I had used the skill so much, a new condition to trigger '■■' had been added. If the skill was triggered now, it meant that an important 'event' branch was coming. And in Omniscient Reader, 'important' was synonymous with 'dangerous'.

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

**[Villain's Crisis]**

「At that moment, Cheon Inho」

■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■

* At your current skill level, you can write a total of 200 additional characters.

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield' for a total of 5 minutes.]

Judging from Killer King and LiteraryGirl64's attitude, it was unlikely that they would charge straight at me.

That said, the danger wasn't coming from them.

The next time I looked up at the ceiling, I saw the culprit.

Since when?

Through the shadows of the 'Edge of Darkness', three shadows slid down the wall, clinging to it. The moment I saw the series of footprints on the wall, I realized how they had managed to come so stealthily.

[Thief Rat's Footprints].

A stealthy maneuvering skill that, while not as spectacular as Lee Jihye's [Ghost Walk], allowed them to literally move like 'dead rats' in the dark.

All three of them had small tear gas canisters in their hands, so it didn't look like they were approaching with good intentions.

Judging by the distance, they would attack in about 1.8 seconds.

At this rate, Killer King and LiteraryGirl64 would die, or at least be mortally wounded.

Killer King was going to kill me anyway, so I might as well leave them be.

However,

「Villain's Crisis.」

I looked at the scene title and thought.

「But 'whose' crisis is this?」

I began to type a sentence.

[This story is plausible.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 90%.]

[There's enough probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk37: Oh? |

[Successfully recreating the scene.]

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

「At that moment, Cheon Inho threw the spike in his right hand forward.」

"What—?"

The startled Killer King and LiteraryGirl64 rolled out of the way to avoid the attack.

However, my spike wasn't aimed at them.

Swoosh!

As my level 20 strength turned into kinetic energy and pierced through the darkness, the shadows lurking between them let out sharp screeches and scattered.

Something dripped through the darkness, and then something exploded in the air.

Pssssh!

Thick purple smoke billowed out. I immediately recognized the smoke for what it was.

Poisonous fog.

Killer King's complexion turned blue.

"Yerin!"

The younger sister, who was very agile, quickly picked up her brother and took refuge near me.

I raised my hands in a sign that I had no intention of attacking. LiteraryGirl64 dropped Killer King on the ground and began to vomit. She must have inhaled the poisonous fog.

I asked Killer King.

"Who are they?"

"You would know better....."

"If I knew, I wouldn't be asking."

Before he could answer, Killer King began to bleed.

His poisoning seemed worse.

Apparently, this was no ordinary poisonous fog. It was poison taken directly from the anal sac of a 'Poison Rhino'.

I took out my emergency supply of Elain Monkey Lungs and popped one into my mouth, then handed the other to Killer King.

Killer King's eyes shook for a moment.

"Bite down on this. Quick, before you die."

Just before he took the lungs and bit them, Killer King spoke in a low voice.

"They are the Misreading Association."

The Misreading Association. I see.

So that's who they are.

The Seven Apostles had the clever trick of utilizing Dionysus's indirect messages as a code, but these guys didn't seem to have anything like that.

Sssssst.

Through the thick violet fog, the men emerged, Elain Monkey Lungs in their mouths.

Upon closer inspection, all three had grayish hair sprouting from their faces.

I immediately activated 'Readers' Comments List'.

[The exclusive skill 'Readers' Comments List' is activated!]

[The person is not a 'reader'.]

That's strange.

Wasn't 'Misreading Association' the name of a readers' community?

I activated 'Character List' just in case.

Then.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

[Since you're viewing multiple characters' information, it will temporarily change to 'Character Summary'.]

**[Character Summary]**

Name: Yoon Shinmin

Sponsor: Plague-Carrying Rat

Exclusive Attributes: Ratman (Rare)

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.15], [Strength Lv.15], [Agility Lv.15], [Magic Power Lv.8]

**[Character Summary]**

Name: Jung Hyunse

Sponsor: Plague-Carrying Rat

Exclusive Attributes: Ratman (Rare)

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.13], [Strength Lv.15], [Agility Lv.15], [Magic Power Lv.6]

**[Character Summary]**

Name: Kang Junsik

Sponsor: Plague-Carrying Rat

Exclusive Attributes: Ratman (Rare)

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.15], [Strength Lv.15], [Agility Lv.14], [Magic Power Lv.4]

Surprisingly, all three men were 'characters'. They even had the same sponsor and attribute.

Plague-Carrying Rat.

And Ratman.

All incarnations of the same constellation, all choosing the path of the outcast (人外).

Even though the outer species were strong in the beginning, would readers who had finished the novel choose the path of an outer species?

It couldn't be.

They're not readers.

Then why did the Killer King call them the 'Misreading Association'?

It was then that I heard a squeak in my ear.

[Your exclusive attribute is activated.]

[You understand the language settings.]

[You are interpreting the language of the Ratmen.]

And then a voice said.

—How's Killer King?

—Poisoned.

—His sister.

—Same. She can still move, but not for long.

—There are others I haven't seen.

I'm getting more and more confused.

I thought only the readers could know that.

But how could people who had only been in this world for three days know that?

"Hey, excuse me. Guys."

The men were talking amongst themselves, as if they couldn't hear me.

—I can tell he's an apostle because he has monkey's lungs.

—Is he a member of the Seven Apostles?

—Most likely.

—We'll have to get rid of him.

I was no match for the three of them.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' looks down at his incarnation with a pitiable glance.]

At that moment, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi, who were sprawled on the floor, began to twitch.

It looked like the poisonous fog was slowly spreading to them.

Fortunately, the two of them had eaten a lot of ground rat meat before falling asleep, so they should be able to hold out a bit longer with the antidote effect.

I turned to see a gasping Killer King staring back at me through narrowed eyes. His entire face was colored a deep purple, as if the Elain Monkey Lungs couldn't keep up.

He was even weaker than he looked. Hadn't he leveled up his stats?

"Are you sure..... you're not from the 'Misreading Association'?"

"I don't know such people."

[The other person has confirmed that the statement is true.]

Killer King opened his mouth.

"I'll believe you. You are certainly—"

"I'm no prophet, but I do know that it's not time for us to fight amongst ourselves."

Nodding, Killer King handed the Elain Monkey Lung he'd been biting to his sister.

"Yerin, I'm sorry, you'll have to do it alone this time."

LiteraryGirl64 shook her head hard, but finally took the lung with trembling hands.

Killer King coughed and spoke.

"The enemy is a low-ranked outer species. Around an 8th or 9th grade archetype, but..... you should be able to deal with them by yourself."

I could recognize the siblings' fighting style. Apparently, the older brother, Killer King, was the brains, while the younger sister did the actual fighting.

Killer King looked in my direction and said.

"I don't trust you. But....."

"You'll owe me a favor."

"I'll pay you back if I can."

With those last words, Killer King closed his eyes. He didn't seem to be dead, just trying to survive his poisoning by minimizing his energy consumption.

I turned to the younger sister.

"I need you to take care of one. We need to finish this before your brother dies."

LiteraryGirl64 staggered to her feet, as if she would do anything.

Meanwhile, the Ratmen's side had finished analyzing this side's power.

—Random item box secured.

—We have a variable, should we rush in?

—Killer King must be eliminated here. If we don't get rid of him now, we might not have a chance in the future.

The Ratmen exchanged sullen glances.

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' laughs sneeringly.]

The next moment, I felt a chill down the back of my neck.

It felt as if hundreds of rats were glaring at me through the purple fog.

The Ratmen sprang back up like toy tumblers and surrounded me.

A Ratman was an 8th-grade outer species.

All three of them had excellent stats, and their attribute bonuses made them extremely fast.

Luckily, LiteraryGirl64, who ran like a flash, took on one of the Ratmen, and an unconventional hand-to-hand battle ensued.

LiteraryGirl64's movements were slower than before due to her poisoning, but it seemed to be enough to take down one Ratman.

That left two.

A Ratman's elongated nails sliced into my skull with obvious murderous intent.

I was terrified. One wrong move and I would die.

I muttered an incantation to make myself stronger.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk. Yoo Joonghyuk, super strong Yoo Joonghyuk, handsome Yoo Joonghyuk.」

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.3' is activated!]

Of course, just inciting myself to be Yoo Joonghyuk didn't really make me Yoo Joonghyuk.

But it would at least make me brave like him. And maybe I could even imitate him a little.

「A pale trajectory sliced through the air.」

Sugagak!

My strength level 20 blow sliced through the air, tearing the arm of one of the Ratmen in two.

Surprised by my strength, the Ratmen jumped back.

—Dangerous. The variable's strength level exceeds 20.

—He's not afraid to get hurt. He's not an ordinary guy.

—Stay away. We'll change the operation.

In an instant, the Ratmen had closed the distance and drawn out a long bamboo pole.

I had an ominous feeling.

"Dodge!"

I reflexively jumped out of the way and swung my sword. I heard the sound of something bouncing off a Ratman's blade. But I didn't manage to deflect them all.

"Ah."

When I looked around, LiteraryGirl64 had a dagger stuck in her thigh.

I quickly supported her and stepped back.

LiteraryGirl64's complexion immediately turned purple.

Damn.

—His agility level is over 20.

—Is there ever an apostle with two stats over 20?

—Maybe he's an apostle possessing a Named.

—Is he from <Kim Dokja's Company>?

The Ratmen craned their necks and looked up into the air at the same time. Like terminals waiting for a signal.

—Says no.

—Then let's get rid of him.

In that moment, I came up with a creepy hypothesis.

The Ratmen in front of me were not 'readers', but they knew information that only 'readers' could know.

That means someone is feeding them information.

Maybe someone who could communicate with them in real time.

I reflexively looked up into the air.

「Did all of the 'Omniscient Reader' readers really only possess 'incarnations'?」

From across the pitch-black darkness, I felt a gaze upon me.

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' looks down on you.]

I thought with a bitter smile.

Sooyoung-ah, isn't this a probability problem?

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Author's Note

Hakhyun-ah, Sooyoung is also busy right now

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 582 Episode 5. Villain (7)

Plague-Carrying Rat.

In Omniscient Reader, and in the setting of Ways of Survival, that constellation hadn't appeared.

Yet, it suddenly signed contracts with three incarnations and sent them out to attack the 'Edge of Darkness'.

That rat was 100% a reader.

I would have loved to have used [Readers' Comments List] on them, but unfortunately it didn't work on targets I couldn't see.

Unless they were possessing an incarnation, there was no way to know.

"Hey, guys, we don't have to fight."

I waved my hand at the Ratmen who were glaring in this direction and slowly backed away.

Even LiteraryGirl64, whom I had relied on, was poisoned, making it a three-on-one fight.

The odds weren't in my favor either way.

However, who was I?

The one who had been called 'The One Who Deceived the Stars' by Yoo Joonghyuk in the 40th turn.

"Misreading Association members, I am not your enemy."

The great villain, the 'Evil Sophist' famous among the constellations.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.3' is activated!]

"Gentlemen, it looks like you're all villains. I happen to be a villain too."

I said, sneaking over to the fallen Killer King.

"So let's make a deal. Is he who you want?"

I grabbed Killer King by the nape of the neck and lifted him up. LiteraryGirl64, who was crouched nearby, looked at me with despair in her eyes.

I smiled lightly at her, then turned back to the Ratmen.

One of the Ratmen said.

"We don't negotiate."

"Stay out of this, ratmen. I'm talking to your constellation, not you."

At my cold voice, the Ratmen frowned.

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' is looking at you with interest.]

I smirked and spoke.

"As you saw me fight just now, you noticed I'm pretty good myself. If I were to fight at full strength, even your incarnations wouldn't come out unscathed. If three of your incarnations die so early, wouldn't it be a heavy blow to a low-tier constellation like you?"

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' is glaring at you.]

"Even so, do we need to fight each other? This is what you want, and I don't want to get blood on my hands. It's a win-win situation. Give what you have to give, take what you have to take."

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' says the Seven Apostles can't be trusted.]

"I am not from the Seven Apostles."

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' has used 'Lie Detection'.]

[Your statement is true.]

Now even a rat constellation is using that skill.

Well, that rat is a constellation too.

"I'll give you Killer King, in exchange for your random item box."

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' says they can't give you the box.]

"Then I'll take the rest of the items here, minus the box."

At my offer, the 'Plague-Carrying Rat' seemed to ponder for a moment.

I could hear the Ratmen asking with their squeaks.

—What shall we do?

I opened my mouth as I stealthily moved toward the wall.

"No need to overthink it, just be reasonable. It seems like you've had a pretty rough time yourself, and if we want to survive in a world like this, we need to cooperate. I don't want a plot where the villains turn on each other and end up self-destructing."

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' asks who the hell you are.]

Tsuchuchut.

Judging by the light sparks all over its body, it was about to unleash its status to intimidate me.

However, the 'Plague-Carrying Rat' didn't seem to be a very powerful constellation.

Nor would it be free from the constraints of Probability at this early stage.

"I'm disappointed. You really don't know who I am? You must not have read the novel properly."

I took another step.

The rat constellation warned me as if it felt something was strange.

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' tells you to stop.]

As if I would.

"This is the body of the worst villain in Omniscient Reader."

With those words, I plucked out the 'Dark Flower' that was plugged in nearby.

For a moment, my shadow flickered ominously as the ash-colored torch that sucked in black ether—the 'Dark Flower'—lit up the surroundings.

"The one burnt to death with Hellfire."

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' orders its incarnations to kill you right away.]

The Ratmen whistled in unison and fired their poisonous darts.

I used Killer King as a shield.

Pow. Pow. Pow.

Wide-eyed, Killer King shuddered convulsively. I had no choice given the circumstances.

I'll save you, dear reader, so hang in there.

With Killer King in front of me, I began to charge at the Ratmen. For a moment, they panicked and jumped back.

I flung the dark flower at them with all my might. It spun in the air, sailed past them, and tumbled into the darkness behind them.

A wisp of black smoke billowed from the extinguished flame.

Black ether was being released.

—Beware!

Something began to stir in the center of the dense black ether.

「There was a 'boss monster' here that hadn't died yet.」

In the novel, Kim Dokja did not directly stop the monster's breath. To do so would incur the curse of the 'Demon King'.

[The ruler of the 'Edge of Darkness' is absorbing the black ether!]

Killer King, who had read Omniscient Reader nearly a hundred times, hadn't forgotten that part.

[The 7th-grade demon, 'Dark Keeper' has revived!]

The black etheric energy from the Dark Flower revived the dying 'Dark Keeper'.

Squeak squeak, the Ratmen screamed, and three or four tentacles shot out of the Dark Keeper's body simultaneously.

The Ratmen barely dodged the tentacles.

However,

Pusyusyusyuk!

They didn't have time to dodge the tentacles that sprang up from the ground below them. In an instant, the three Ratmen screamed and struggled as their stomachs were pierced.

"Kallitu."

With the Dark Keeper's words, something slithered into the three Ratmen's bodies.

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' is furious!]

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' is increasing its synchronization with the incarnations!]

Realizing the situation too late, the Plague-Carrying Rat tried to intervene.

But it was a mistake.

Tsuchuchuchuchut!

[The 7th grade demon, 'Dark Keeper' has noticed the presence of the constellation.]

[The 7th grade demon, 'Dark Keeper' prays to its master.]

Kukukukuku.

The whole of the 'Edge of Darkness' shook as if there had been an earthquake.

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' panics.]

Someone was looking into this space.

A being far different from 'Plague-Carrying Rat'.

A cold sweat ran down my spine.

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' is increasing its synchronization with the incarnations!]

He was the owner of the 32nd Demon Realm.

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos's face hardens.]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow's eyes shine.]

The Devil of Lust and Wrath.

The Demon King Asmodeus.

[The Demon King 'Devil of Lust and Wrath' stares at 'Plague-Carrying Rat'.]

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' was dealt a fatal blow.]

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' groans in terror.]

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' has left the channel.]

A historical-grade constellation had been defeated with just a single glance.

[The demon king 'Devil of Lust and Wrath' is looking at you with strange eyes.]

From the other side of the abyss, the demon king was looking at me.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.3' is strongly activated!]

「I am Kim Dokja, who possesses the 'Fourth Wall'.」

I met the Demon King's gaze undaunted.

[The demon king 'Devil of Lust and Wrath' is interested in you.]

[The demon king 'Devil of Lust and Wrath' will remember your name.]

After the message, the gaze vanished. All that remained was the Dark Keeper and me.

I sucked in a breath and stared at him.

"Are you going to fight?"

The Dark Keeper stared back at me and muttered something.

[You understand the language settings.]

[You are interpreting the language of the demon species.]

...From ■■ to ■. The King is watching you.

...What?

With those words, it disappeared into the darkness with the Ratmen.

[The 7th grade demon, 'Dark Keeper' has disappeared from the Ground Rat's Treasure Trove.]

[The 7th grade demon, 'Dark Keeper' has been defeated!]

[The sub scenario 'Kill the Keeper' has ended.]

[You have successfully looted someone else's sub scenario!]

[8,000 coins have been earned.]

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' admires your courage in the face of a demon king.]

[1,000 coins have been additionally sponsored.]

I was preparing to fight the Dark Keeper if I had to. It was a relief.

So this kind of development is possible too.

In the back, I could see Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein stumbling to their feet.

"Inho-ssi? Ow! What the..."

Judging by their exaggerated voices, they must have woken up earlier and faked being unconscious to observe the situation.

I laughed bitterly and pointed at Killer King and LiteraryGirl64 on the ground.

"Let's save them first."

---

According to Ways of Survival's settings notes, there are two ways to dispel the 'poisonous fog'.

Using the 'Elain Monkey Lungs', or feeding the 'Elain Forest Essence'.

However, I couldn't guarantee that Killer King or LiteraryGirl64 would recover with either of those two methods.

Especially Killer King; he had been poisoned too many times because of me, and his condition was critical.

"Kup, Kuhup."

Killer King's face was ashen, and he was gasping for air with foam at his mouth.

Still, I couldn't let a reader who had read the novel 99 times die like this.

I pulled out the piece of 'Poison Rhino's horn' I had hidden in my chest and ground it into a fine powder.

Dansoo ahjussi asked.

"What is that?"

"I picked it up the other day when I met Yoo Joonghyuk."

If my ligaments were still intact, I would have gotten a bigger piece, but my arm was destroyed, so I could only get crumbs.

Luckily, it was enough for now.

I mixed the horn powder with water and poured it into the mouths of Killer King and LiteraryGirl64.

After a few moments, Killer King and LiteraryGirl64's complexions became noticeably brighter.

「The Poison Rhino's horn has a great effect on the 'poisonous fog'.」

I hadn't realized that it would be used in this way, as I had only created it as a 'Ways of Survival' setting and hadn't used it in the main story.

"Everyone else should take some. It's good for treating the poisonous fog."

"How did you know about this?"

"I experimented with it as soon as I got a piece of horn."

"As expected of Inho-ssi.....!"

I recounted what happened a moment ago to Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein as they drank the remaining bottled water.

I purposely didn't tell them about Killer King trying to kill us. I thought there was no need to create animosity at this point.

"There was also a reader who possessed a constellation? And that was a member of the Misreading Association?"

Kyung Sein seemed almost out of breath when she heard the name Misreading Association.

"Oh, you fought with the Misreading Association?"

"Yes. But they were a little weird?"

Killer King was one thing, but the person possessed by that Plague-Carrying Rat was truly bizarre. Even if they had entered a novel, how could someone who had been living in the real world until just a few days ago suddenly turn into a cold-blooded killer?

Kyung Sein, whose complexion had turned blue, spoke up.

"If it's the Misreading Association, it's possible. Damn it, I can't believe we're meeting them so soon....."

I became a little confused.

"Isn't it just a club?"

"Misreading Association is not just a club."

Huh? Then?

It was Killer King, who had finally regained consciousness, who answered my question.

"Misreading Association is the name of an illegal sharing site."

---

Author's Note

Due to an error on another platform, we had to rush to upload this chapter, which was shceduled for Sunday at 7pm.

The next chapter will be published normally on Monday at 7pm.

We apologize for any confusion this may have caused our readers.

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T/N: If you ever enter Omniscient Reader or Ways of Survival, please refrain from killing people just because. Remember that you can buy the chapters if you can on Naver or Munpia. 10 chapters cost 1 dollar.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 583 Episode 5. Villain (8)

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Misreading Association (誤讀協).

Initially, the site started as a community of people collecting rare books.

It was a small club where members read books that were discontinued in Korea or were otherwise unavailable, or untranslated classics, and exchanged opinions.

However, as the number of members gradually increased and the site grew, problems began to arise.

"Some of the members started to share illegally not only rare books, but also manhwa and web novels that were actively being serialized without permission."

As word spread that paid content was available for free, the site ballooned, eventually taking on the form of a business. Adult ads were plastered across the pages, and illegal gambling money began to flow in.

A few years later, the founding members disappeared, and it became a completely illegal sharing site.

After listening to Kyung Sein's full explanation, I was confused.

"You said the Seven Apostles fought the Misreading Association before."

"Ah, yes."

"Then did the Seven Apostles fight that illegal site?"

"Well, that's....."

Kyung Sein looked at Killer King, and then added quietly.

"The Seven Apostles got into a fight with anonymous readers, who turned out to be people who had read the novel illegally on the 'Misreading Association'.

I finally understood what was going on.

They were referring to people who read and shared illegal copies of the novel.

Apparently, in this world, people who read the novel through that route were also transmigrated.

Killer King said.

"I don't know about you, but many writers stopped creating or even took their own lives because of the Misreading Association."

"....."

"They illegally consumed content that someone dedicated their life to. A lot of my favorite authors disappeared because of them."

In fact, some of my fellow writers had stopped writing because of illegal sharing.

"Is that why you fought them?"

Killer King shook his head without answering.

Honestly, I was impressed.

As a writer, I had often been frustrated by the lack of success in combating illegal sharing, but to see a reader like Killer King being so proactive was surprising.

He was fighting in real life, not just in the comment section.

I suddenly wondered what kind of comments Killer King would have left.

[The exclusive skill 'Readers' Comments List' is activated!]

ID: killer_king

Platform: Sirius, Paper books

Total Comments: 491

Reader Level: 99

Number of Readings: 99.8 times

* You can use coins to view the comments written by this reader.

* Number of comments currently available for free: 3.

I clicked on [View Comments] without hesitation.

I am Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Upvotes 0 / Downvotes 1

(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 1)

I am Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Upvotes 0 / Downvotes 1

(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 23)

I am Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Upvotes 0 / Downvotes 1

(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 77)

I couldn't believe my eyes.

Feeling my gaze, Killer King frowned at me.

"What are you looking at?"

"Nothing, just....."

"Keep looking at me like that and I'll kill you."

"You really sound like Yoo Joonghyuk."

With a light groan, Killer King sat up and looked away.

He reminded me of a sulky younger cousin, and I was about to tease him one more time when I heard a voice behind me.

"Hey, thanks for saving me."

LiteraryGirl64, who had finally regained consciousness, lowered her head helplessly.

I waved my hands and said.

"No, I was lucky."

"You were lucky."

Killer King added with a nuance that somehow made me feel good.

"They didn't take the random item box."

With that, we stared at the shiny box the Ratmen had dropped.

Killer King and his sister were probably here for that box, too.

Just as things were starting to get uncomfortable, Killer King spoke up.

"I'll give it to you guys."

LiteraryGirl64 nodded in agreement.

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi's faces lit up.

Nevertheless, I shook my head.

"No, thank you. We'll just take the rest of the items."

"Are you serious?"

"Yes. The other items are enough for us."

I looked down at the items on the floor.

I saw the D-grade items that Kim Dokja had picked up in the main story, as well as other items that hadn't appeared in the main story.

As if to give me one last chance, Killer King asked again.

"Didn't you read the novel properly? Don't you realize the value of this item box?"

"Seriously, the rest is enough for us. Go ahead."

Killer King hesitated for a moment, then took the item box in his arms, his eyes filled with desire.

"I owe you. I'll pay you back."

With that, Killer King turned around and began to walk away.

LiteraryGirl64 bowed her head and ran after him.

I asked Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi to sort through the items, then escorted Killer King and his sister to the entrance of the Edge of Darkness.

Just before we crossed the edge, Killer King paused.

Neither Dansoo ahjussi nor Kyung Sein could hear us from where they were.

"I tried to kill you all."

"You did, and it was a really bad thing."

"Why didn't you tell them that?"

"But you didn't kill us."

Killer King frowned, unable to figure me out.

"You, what's your name?"

"Cheon Inho."

"That Cheon Inho?"

"Yes."

For some reason, this name elicited the same reaction from everyone who heard it.

"I can't believe you possessed that scumbag. I hope you're not using the Cheoldoo Group to kill people."

"If I were, you'd be dead too."

"You..... Who the hell are you?"

I shrugged and laughed.

For a moment, Killer King's eye flickered with black energy. He had activated the stigma [Eye of Sin].

I was suddenly curious.

"What do I look like to you?"

In his eyes, 'Cheon Inho' was marked as 'the murderer of nineteen people'.

「I am Lee Hakhyun.」

Then what does 'writer Lee Hakhyun' look like?

"What....."

The next moment, Killer King's eyes widened, his entire retina turning pitch black like it was full of ink.

I wondered.

What did my sins read in his eyes?

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' is startled!]

Tsuchuchuchuchut!

[The stigma 'Eye of Sin' has forcibly ended.]

Groaning in pain, Killer King looked at me with the eye that had used the stigma.

"What the hell are you? No..... that can't be. Something must be broken."

Muttering to himself, Killer King looked at me and said.

"There's no way such a villain exists in this world."

Killer King looked at me.

He was looking at me with clear eyes that weren't using [Eye of Sin], eyes that had probably read Omniscient Reader 99 times.

"I wish you the blessing of the story."

With those last words, Killer King walked away without looking back.

The younger sister glanced back at me a few times, then followed her brother into the darkness beyond.

I stood still and waved until they were completely out of sight.

Hopefully, they too would be blessed by the story.

---

Among the items that Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi had gathered, there were some that were more useful than I thought.

"You can have this shield, Sein-ssi."

"As expected, 'Old Iron Shield' is the rule for tankers."

Old Iron Shield.

An item used by Lee Hyunsung in the original novel.

Among us, it was the most suited for Kyung Sein to use.

"I'll give you the Magic Power Recovery Bracelet."

"Is it okay if I take it..... Thank you."

Ahjussi put the bracelet on his wrist as if it were a luxury watch and smiled happily.

That bracelet would be quite useful, since he used [Diverse Communication].

Other than that, there were rings with faint anti-demonic abilities and gloves that provided a very slight defense boost.

It was a bit lacking, but this early in the scenarios, it was good enough.

The last thing that caught my eye was an item that looked like spoiled jelly.

**[Item Information]**

Name: Unrealized Thought

Rating: D

Description: A shapeless weapon of the past. It could have been anything, but ultimately became nothing.

Come to think of it, I had designed an item like this. It was just a setting in my notes, and I never expected to find it here.

Once again, I felt certain.

There were countless 'settings' in this world that hadn't made it into the main story, but had remained in my notes.

「So, did I make those settings, or did Han Sooyoung tell me about them?」

It was then that Kyung Sein spoke up.

"By the way, Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"The random item box, why did you give it up?"

I had wondered why she hadn't asked that yet.

By the look on her face, she had been agonizing over it. One might think I had just thrown away a winning lottery ticket.

Well, my reasons were more valuable than a winning lottery ticket.

"Actually, I was wondering the same thing, mate."

Dansoo ahjussi raised his hand cautiously.

No wonder it looked strange in their eyes.

It wasn't just any item, but the 'random item box'.

It was an essential item to restore Kim Dokja's star relic, Unbroken Faith.

My reasoning for surrendering the item box was simple.

"That box, I wouldn't be able to use it anyway."

"What?"

"Someone else already used it."

"No way..... Who?"

"Did those Misreading Association guys secretly use it?"

I shook my head at Dansoo ahjussi's words.

"Someone already came here before us."

I was sure of it. I had checked the item box myself for a brief moment, and its usage count was already at zero.

Dansoo ahjussi asked.

"Was there a reader who came before us?"

"We started at Geumho Station and only got here today. Our friend who read Omniscient Reader 99 times only arrived here today."

"Then who the hell could have....."

"Common sense tells me there's only one person who can do this at this point."

As if realizing who I was referring to, Kyung Sein swallowed hard and said.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

I nodded.

It was only about a stop and a half from Oksu Station to here.

If it was the same Yoo Joonghyuk who could defeat a 7th-grade demonic species in a single blow, he could have made the trip in under an hour.

Kyung Sein, who was thinking about something, muttered.

"Yes, in the third round, Yoo Joonghyuk stole only the treasures, but I don't remember him

knowing about the 'random item box' back then."

"There's a description that mentions he heard about it from the Heavenly Maid Hori in the 6th round. It's the 41st round, so of course he knew."

"Ah....."

Kyung Sein lowered her head with a dejected expression.

Dansoo ahjussi, who had a serious look on his face, also shook his head.

"It's certainly a lot different from the 3rd round with Kim Dokja."

"Very different."

Even though it was only the 41st turn, this Yoo Joonghyuk's experiences were vastly different from the 3rd turn.

It was probably safe to say that Yoo Joonghyuk would take many of the items Kim Dokja had utilized in the beginning.

Kyung Sein suddenly raised her head and opened her mouth.

"Wait, so the box Killer King took earlier....."

Thinking he would be angry at being tricked by a villain, Kyung Sein asked in admiration,

"Wow..... Inho-ssi, when did you plan that much?"

"When I realized the box had been robbed."

"You're so mean and smart."

"Thank you."

"I'm glad I'm on your side, Inho-ssi. Although it's a shame about the box....."

Dansoo ahjussi said, looking at the items we had obtained.

"Still, we got a lot of stuff."

It wasn't all fruitless though, as we got some useful items in the beginning, including the ahjussi's bracelet and Kyung Sein's shield.

But it's a shame to just take these.....

I pondered for a moment, then looked back at the spot where the 'random item box' had been placed.

It was around here.

I crouched down on the ground and started digging.

Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein looked puzzled at my sudden movement. I turned to them and said.

"If you don't mind, please help me. Something is bothering me."

"Did Omniscient Reader say there was something else here?"

"No, I don't think so."

I wasn't sure either, but it was better than not checking.

「"Author-nim. I think it's a little..... no matter how popular it is these days."」

I heard Ji Eunyu's voice in my head.

It was a memory from five years ago.

She was working hard on the first draft of 'Omniscient Reader'.

「"If you give things like this from the beginning, there's no tension."
"Then what should I do?"
"I think it's better to go with the first draft."
"That sounds good, right?"」

I don't know how long the three of us dug.

I felt something hard on my fingertips.

"Ugh, what's here?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' widens their eyes.]

We shook off the dirt, lifting the object in the hole at the same time.

After a moment, the pitch-black dirt slid away, revealing the object we had pulled out.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' opens his mouth.]

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is surprised.]

What we found was a black box with a familiar appearance.

Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein looked down at the box in a daze, then turned to me and asked.

"Inho-ssi, is this.....?"

I remembered Ji Eunyu's words.

Originally, there was more than one 'random item box' hidden here.

---

Author's Note

If I keep digging, will it keep coming out?

---

T/N: I'm paying for the chapters, so if you can, please support the authors by buying them on Naver or Munpia.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 584 Episode 6. Star Relic (1)

Back when I didn't know much about web novels, I briefly attended a web novel academy on Ji Eunyu's recommendation.

The instructor was a writer who had defined a generation of genre literature.

He had a quiet, nervous voice and spoke so slowly that I dozed off through the entire class.

However, one thing he said stayed with me.

"Don't hesitate to include chances, the more the merrier. Give them to the main character."

The instructor who used to live by those words disappeared from my life. I often imagined that maybe he transmigrated to the novel he wrote.

Just like me now.

"I-I-it's real! Inho-ssi! It's real!"

"It is."

Who would have thought that I would be the one to retrieve a hidden piece.

Kyung Sein let out a scream of delight, shaking the box and turning it over several times.

"How did you know? It doesn't say anything about this in Omniscient Reader!"

To be honest, I was just as confused.

This box was an item from the rough draft of Chapter 23 of Omniscient Reader.

「An item described in the manuscript that was cut in the second draft.」

Anyway, the settings existed, so I looked it up just in case, and the item was indeed there.

Here's the question.

If this was a setting from 'Ways of Survival', then of course Kim Dokja would have used this box in the original novel.

However, since Kim Dokja didn't use it, it meant that this 'box' was never mentioned in the text of 'Ways of Survival'.

So, since when had this setting existed?

From the moment I conceived it? Or from the moment Han Sooyoung handed me the manuscript?

The more I thought about it, the more my head spun.

Is this really the '41st turn' of Ways of Survival that I know?

I didn't know.

For now, we had the item, so I decided to focus on that.

I replied to Kyung Sein.

"It just occurred to me that this box was originally an item made by a dokkaebi and then discarded."

The box, which was dangerous enough to unbalance the scenario, was once an item in the Bureau designed by a mad dokkaebi.

"Uh..... that's right?"

"But did they really just dump that one item..... only one in the same place?"

"Wow, really. Wow."

After hearing my explanation, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi each grabbed their knifes and

started poking around the floor.

Of course, they wouldn't find another box.

There were only two of these boxes.

[Some constellations are shocked to discover the existence of the item.]

[A few constellations protest, asking when they released such an item.]

[A very small number of constellations start to point out the probability problem.]

A few constellations started to protest, but Bihyung didn't seem to have noticed yet.

I had wondered if he would close the channel and run away like in the original story, but I was glad he didn't.

I needed to see the reactions of the constellations.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is interested in your luck.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' asks if that box is real.]

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' widens its eyes in disbelief.]

In this world, there were countless 'readers', including myself.

Based on what I learned from the encounter with the Misreading Association, readers were possessing not only incarnations, but also constellations.

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' taps its chin with its forefoot.]

I looked carefully at the indirect messages from the constellations.

If any of them were readers, they would surely drop clues without realizing it.

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' piles up bricks.]

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier tells you to enter the box.]

I observed each subsequent message, trying to figure out who they were.

Some looked like normal constellations.

Some looked like they were possessed by readers.

Some were hard to tell apart.

Some were possessed by readers but remained true to their constellation concepts.

Some were possessed by readers who didn't understand the concept of constellations at all.

Some were just plain weird.

Of course, this was all speculation on my part.

After all, what could you really tell from a single line of an indirect message?

But since they had all read Omniscient Reader, it wouldn't take much for them to act like proper constellations.

By the way... where was Sneaky Schemer?

I was most curious about that guy's reaction.

"I guess that's the only box, I can't find anything else."

Apparently, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi were still digging.

"Ugh..... well, we have one. It's too bad we don't have a Broken Faith, because that's all we need for Unbroken Faith!"

As Kyung Sein said, we would only need that, but I couldn't get my hands on a Broken Faith right away.

So I made a decision.

"I've been thinking about it, and since we're at this point, why don't we try something different?"

"Something different?"

I pulled out an item I had just gotten from near the box.

**[Item information]**

Name: Unrealized Thought

Rating: D

Description: A shapeless weapon of the past. It could have been anything, but ultimately became nothing.

An item that looked like spoiled jelly at first glance.

"If you guys don't mind, I'd like to put this item in."

"This is... didn't this item not appear in Omniscient Reader?"

Right. It probably wasn't used in Ways of Survival either.

Kim Dokja wasn't particularly interested in this item, either.

Kyung Sein glanced at the Unrealized Thought and replied,

"Well, we wouldn't have found the box if it weren't for you, Inho-ssi, so it's up to you."

Dansoo ahjussi nodded.

"I think so too."

"Wow, we're becoming a bit like <Kim Dokja's Company>, aren't we?"

"Haha, I guess so."

The two of them conceded so readily, I almost felt rather sorry.

"Thank you then."

Without further ado, I put 'Unrealized Thought' into the 'random item box'.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier says it's a risky choice.]

I knew it was a risky choice.

But in the first place, there was a chance of failure no matter what I put in.

"Now we just need the catalyst..."

"The core of a demonic species, right?"

"Yes."

To use the box like in the original story, we need to put the target item and the demonic species' core inside.

Unfortunately, we failed to hunt the Dark Keeper, a 7th-grade demonic species.

For now, it's best to buy one from the auction... though I don't know what kind of madman would risk a Demon King's curse to hunt a demonic species this early.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' asks if you need a 'Demonic Species Core'.]

We looked up in surprise.

What was even more surprising was its next words.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says that it can give you the 'Demonic Species Core'.]

Kyung Sein, who was looking up at the air with us, asked in a thoughtful voice,

"Tiger Eating Rice Cakes is the one from the traditional fairy tale, right? 'The Sun and the Moon'....."

I nodded.

Because that's the only fairy tale that comes to mind when I think of Korean 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakess'.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says it's him.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' picks his nose and asks if he's a famous constellation.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' timidly replies that he is a bit famous on the Korean Peninsula.]

To get an item sponsored by a constellation this early. Even Kim Dokja had never received such a sponsorship at this stage.

If he was sponsoring an item so early on, he had to have a reason.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says he has a favor to ask in exchange for the 'Demonic Species Core'.]

As I said.

"I appreciate the offer, but....."

Normally, this kind of deal would be followed by a ridiculous request.

That's Kim Dokja's proverb.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says he only needs you to attend one 'Twelve Zodiacs Ball' later.]

Twelve Zodiacs Ball?

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says it's just a twelve zodiacs social event.]

This was another unexpected suggestion.

Twelve Zodiacs Ball.

It was probably the zodiac version of the 'Constellation Banquet' or the 'Gourmet Association'.

As they listened to the message, Kyung Sein and ahjussi whispered.

"Wow, it's the <Twelve Zodiacs>....."

"They're the rat, cow, tiger, rabbit, dragon, snake, horse, sheep, monkey, chicken, dog, and pig. Right?"

"That's..... right."

"When I was young, there was a cartoon movie with twelve zodiacs as the main characters....."

In the original story, the constellations of the <Twelve Zodiacs> nebula were Kim Dokja's enemies.

But this time, the situation was a little different.

Was it because I was a villain?

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says there's no need to feel pressured.]

I've made my decision.

"I'll attend the Twelve Zodiacs Ball. Is that really all I have to do?"

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says that's really it.]

"Okay, then."

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is greatly pleased.]

[A '7th-grade Demonic Species Core' has been sponsored.]

It was a very cool sponsorship.

A pitch-black orb then appeared from thin air.

'7th-grade Demonic Species Core'.

It was even superior in color.

Tsuchuchuchut.

Judging by the faint sparks, it seemed that the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' had used up quite a bit of Probability.

What was he up to, showing such sincerity to me when I wasn't even his incarnation?

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' is sharing the Probability of 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' is sharing the Probability of 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.]

[The constellation 'Dog Who Threw Himself Into the Flames' is sharing the Probability of 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' claps his hands at the animal brothers.]

Anyway, thanks to my animal friends, I had gathered all the ingredients.

Looking at the glowing core, Kyung Sein said excitedly.

"Oh, go ahead and put it in, Inho-ssi!"

"Why don't the three of us close it together?"

"Okay."

We closed the box.

Kyung Sein chanted.

"God! Buddha! Demon King of Salvation! Please!"

A moment later, a bright light emanated from the box.

---

A place dozens of steps away from the core of the 'Edge of Darkness'.

In the center of the deep, black ether of the 'Dark Root', a woman in a white coat stood.

"Wow....."

She frowned at the 'random item box' glowing in the distance.

"Even the box was taken? From me? Is that even possible?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' asks why didn't you move faster.]

"Who's that guy?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says he seems to be a reader from another world line.]

"A reader?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says yes.]

The woman tilted her head at that, then smiled, baring her fangs.

"Is that so?"

In her hand was Broken Faith, which no reader in this world should have been able to get.

---

Author's Note

You know everything now, right?

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

# 585 Episode 6. Star Relic (2)

"Demon King of Salvation-nim! Watcher of Light and Darkness-nim! Please!"

As Kyung Sein prayed, light exploded from the box.

And.

[An item of unknown origin was placed inside the box.]

[The box contained a lock of someone's hair.]

Hair?

No, wait.

Was there a foreign substance mixed in?

[The item is causing a strange transformation!]

[The origin of the sacrificed item is confirmed.]

[A top-rated item has appeared!]

[The number of available random item boxes is 0.]

After a while, the glow subsided.

Kyung Sein, Dansoo ahjussi, and I looked at each other, swallowed hard, and opened the box at the same time.

Inside the box was a vibrant, light-blue colored slime, about the size of an adult male's fist.

Kyung Sein frowned.

"It's changed color? It's like Biyoo's poop."

"Let's check it out."

I went straight for the slime. But just before I reached for it, the slime squirmed and dodged my hand.

Upon closer inspection, the slime had eyes. Narrowed eyes.

"Giw—me."

It even had a tiny mouth.

I wondered if it looked like me.

"Giw—me. Giw—me."

Kyung Sein tilted her head.

"Is it swearing?"

"No, I think it's saying, 'give me'. I think it's asking for food."

"How do you know?"

"Because it's similar to the way Jiyoon used to babble..."

After a moment's hesitation, Dansoo ahjussi hesitantly handed over the leftover ground rat meat.

The slime looked at it, and then jumped at his hand. It didn't eat the ground rat meat, but rather went for the bracelet he was wearing.

Dansoo ahjussi startled and jumped back.

"Wilson!"

Apparently, he had named the bracelet.

The slime quickly realized the bracelet was tasteless, spat it out, and curled up with a squeak.

And the next moment.

"Huh?"

The slime had turned into a bracelet.

---

After we finished organizing our items, we made our escape from the 'Edge of Darkness'.

Luckily, ahjussi had a cockroach in his pocket, so it wasn't hard to find our way out.

But... why did the back of my head keep itching?

"Inho-ssi, is there something wrong?"

"No, it's just..."

I muttered, peering into the pitch-black 'Edge of Darkness'.

"It's just that I feel like someone keeps looking at me."

"Oh, it's just your imagination."

"Even the bugs say there's nothing there."

If ahjussi says there's nothing there, there's nothing there.

At this point, the only person he couldn't detect with his [Diverse Communication] was Killer King.

By now, he must be holding the empty box, his eyes burning with murderous intent as he repeatedly muttered 'Cheon Inho'.

Well... at least I didn't leave him completely empty-handed, so I guess it was fine.

If he made good use of the notes I put inside the box, he would still get a decent haul.

Of course, whatever he got would be worth less than the bracelet on my wrist.

**[Item Information]**

Name: Thoughts of Almost Everything

Rating: Star Relic (遺物)

Description: A mysterious slime born from a constellation's obsession with studying 'almost everything'.

When worn, it increases Agility and Magic Power levels by 1 each.

* 'Idea' can use 'mimicry'.

Formed Idea (意態).

'Thoughts of Almost Everything' can mimic an item by touching it.

Since it was a high-grade item, it couldn't mimic others simply by touching them, but only after certain conditions were met.

Once successfully mimicked, the item could be used continuously until the mimicked form was destroyed.

However, the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' could refuse to obey its owner's 'mimicry command'.

As one could tell from the description, this was a cheat item. In theory, it could be almost anything.

However, the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' had two fatal flaws.

First, it couldn't be used if you didn't meet the 'mimicry' conditions.

Second, the 'idea' itself could refuse the owner's commands.

So, perhaps it wasn't such a cheat item after all.

Kyung Sein, who was walking beside me, looked at my bracelet with envy.

"Sein-ssi, I'll get you a nice star relic as well."

"Really? N-No need."

"What would you like to have?"

"Heracles' Shield."

What?

As we walked along, making small talk, we arrived at the platform of Geumho Station.

However, Jung Heewon was nowhere to be found.

"Heewon-ssi...?"

"Oh, she woke up thirty minutes ago and went to get food with some people earlier."

Something to eat.

It was time to worry about that.

I asked Bang Cheolsoo what had happened.

"Did anything happen?"

Judging by the strange looks on their faces, something had happened.

Bang Cheolsoo began his report in a slightly nervous voice.

"A few things happened."

The first report was about monstrous creatures roaming around Geumho Station.

"Well, they didn't look like monsters, but they weren't human either..."

According to Bang Cheolsoo, the creatures had started lingering around a few hours ago.

My mind raced.

"Do they look like rats?"

"Some looked like rats, some looked like lizards."

I had a vague idea of who they were. Probably incarnations under the command of the Misreading Association.

"Anything else?"

"A scenario penalty has been added."

Scenario. Sure enough, I got a message too.

I hit notifications, and they popped up one after the other.

[A scenario penalty has been added.]

[From now on, food stockpiling is limited.]

[All existing stockpiled food has disappeared.]

[The 'survival cost' clause has been added.]

[From now on, 100 coins will be deducted every night for the 'survival cost'. If you can't pay the 'survival cost', you will die.]

[The 'survival cost' penalty will be maintained until the second main scenario is cleared.]

A food stockpiling ban and a survival cost penalty.

No wonder Jung Heewon went to get food.

"Let's gather the people for a moment."

Despite all the stockpiled food disappearing, the group didn't seem to be in despair.

Perhaps it was because this group had a different starting point than the one in the 3rd turn.

They shared their food and stuck together in the face of crisis.

"Gather round! The boss is looking for you!"

"Come on quickly!"

The scattered, hungry people began to gather one by one.

"Inho ahjussi!"

Dayoung, who was riding on Bang Cheolsoo's shoulders, waved at me. As I gently held her hand, I suddenly remembered Yoo Joonghyuk.

He had come to Geumho Station the day I was eaten by the ichthyosaur.

「"Cheon Inho is already dead. The marginalized group can come out in peace. I'll show you how to get food from now on."」

At that time, Yoo Joonghyuk wasn't trying to kill people. Rather, he had come here to save them.

Now that I thought about it, it didn't make sense.

This was the 41st turn.

A world where Yoo Joonghyuk was the most ruthless man in all of 'Ways of Survival'.

And yet, he was trying to save these people.

"Inho-ssi?"

"Ah, yes. Is everyone here?"

Looking around, there were around 80 people.

Judging from the decrease in number, some had left for other areas, excluding those who had followed Jung Heewon to get food.

I started talking.

"I'm guessing you all received a 'survival cost' penalty."

A few people reacted to the words survival cost.

"That's right, suddenly we have to pay something every night....."

"How are we supposed to earn coins?"

I calmly explained.

"Coins can be earned from the sponsorship of the constellations or by completing scenarios."

"Scenarios..... That's the one we did at the beginning, right?"

"Do I have to kill people again?"

People's eyes filled with fear again.

Most of the people here had already killed in the first scenario. But few of them killed for the sake of killing.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' despises the weakness of the incarnations.]

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' says that children who can't control themselves should be abandoned.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' advises against wasting time on the wrong things.]

The constellations weren't wrong.

However, if we train them in such a harsh way, most of them will not survive.

People like Dayoung, who was pulling Bang Cheolsoo's ear, and Dayoung's mother, who was scolding her, wouldn't have survived.

[The constellation 'Dog Who Threw Himself Into the Flames' understands your intentions.]

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier pays attention to your choice.]

So, this decision was the least I could do for the extras who had died without any chance in the original story.

"You could kill other people and take their coins, but I don't recommend that. Frankly, I don't think anyone here wants to resort to that anyway."

"I-Is there any other way to earn coins?"

I nodded and looked toward the tunnel.

"Well, we're running out of food... and that's actually a good thing."

"What? Why would you say that..."

Just then, Jung Heewon and the others returned from the tunnel, dragging the corpse of a ground rat.

"Ah, Inho-ssi!"

Jung Heewon waved happily, and I waved back.

---

"No matter how hard I looked, there was no food. The surface is covered in poisonous fog, so we can't go up... So I brought this back, thinking we might be able to eat it..."

"Well done."

I instructed the Cheoldoo Group to carry the ground rat carcass onto the platform.

A few people stumbled back in surprise.

"From now on, this is your food."

"What, we're eating this? Do you know what this is....."

"It's the same meat. Just a different recipe."

I proclaimed myself a 'professional butcher' and began to carve the meat from the carcass.

Jung Heewon, Kyung Sein, and Dansoo ahjussi helped me without hesitation, probably because they had seen it before.

"Take turns!"

Jeong Heewon handed each one a piece of meat.

Once everyone had received a piece, I pulled out the Magic Power Stove I had obtained from the Edge of Darkness.

"This is an item called a 'Magic Power Stove'."

I placed the meat on the Magic Power Stove. I increased the power of the stove, and the meat was deliciously roasted in less than a dozen seconds.

Dayoung muttered happily.

"Mom, it smells delicious..."

As I took a bite to demonstrate, the crowd rushed toward the stove, having waited for this moment.

After rolling up their sleeves, Bang Cheolsoo and the Cheoldoo Group took over and grilled the meat for them.

"Does anyone have salt?"

"Hyung-ssi, there's no salt here, just eat it!"

Groans of satisfaction echoed through the platform. After all, they hadn't tasted meat in three days.

But my true purpose wasn't just to feed everyone.

[The sub scenario 'Food Acquisition' has been completed early.]

[500 coins have been earned.]

The sub scenario 'Food Acquisition' can only be completed by cooking a 'self-hunted monster'.

The carcasses that Jung Heewon brought back this time were the ones that Kyung Sein, Dansoo ahjussi, and I hunted.

Presumably, the others did not receive the rewards we did.

"From now on, all food must be obtained by hunting monsters."

At the mention of hunting, the faces of those picking at the meat stiffened.

"For now, my companions and I have provided this meat, but we cannot continue this way indefinitely. You must learn to hunt for yourselves if you want to survive."

My words were no different from those of Yoo Joonghyuk, who had come here not long before.

He was right, and he was trying to give these people what they needed.

They just weren't ready to receive it.

"As you can see in the scenario window, you earn coins by hunting and cooking ground rats. If you're short on coins, you can earn 500 coins by hunting one today."

Those who checked the scenario window at my words said.

"It's true, it says it will give us coins."

"But how are we supposed to catch a monster like this?"

"Everyone, don't be scared. I caught one, and so did this ahjussi."

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi stepped up to my side to support my words, and I could see a few people shaking their heads at them.

I quickly added before anyone could complain.

"We'll show you how to catch them."

---

Dansoo ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Jung Heewon, and I taught the people step-by-step how to hunt ground rats.

It was valuable information we had to learn through blood, sweat, and tears—something that never appeared in the text of Omniscient Reader.

Kyung Sein, who still had bite marks all over her body, squared her shoulders and said.

"Their patterns are very simple. As long as you stay calm, you can easily catch them!"

Though they certainly bit us a lot despite that simple pattern.

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' is pleased with your actions.]

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' announces your good deeds.]

[The constellations of the 'absolute good' system approve of your actions.]

[1,200 coins have been sponsored.]

In this world, good deeds become coins.

No matter what you do, the results of your actions are directly related to coins.

I wonder if Kim Dokja felt the same way.

However, I didn't have time to ponder for long. We were still too weak and unprepared for the upcoming scenarios.

I could understand why Kim Dokja was so obsessed with coins. Having plenty of coins didn't mean one could do everything, but it certainly opened up more options.

Next stop, Chungmuro.

If I wanted to deal with the bald man at Chungmuro, I had to start saving up coins now.

The Ten Evil of Chungmuro Station.

Armed Fortress Master Gong Pildu.

Although he was a character with as much presence as hair in the original story, Gong Pildu was a terrifying villain in the early scenarios.

[Coins Possessed: 11,800 C]

This was a world where even early skills like the [Woryeong Sword Technique] cost 8,000 coins.

With the coins I had now, I didn't even have enough to raise my stats, let alone take care of my companions.

I wished coins would fall from the sky. Kim Dokja really had it easy, earning coins just by breathing.

[The constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' has entered the channel.]

I looked up at the channel entry notification.

[The constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' snoops around Geumho Station.]

Lily Blooming in Aquarius.

Gabriel, the archangel of <Eden>, had entered the channel.

I wondered what brought her to this obscure channel, but her gaze soon settled on a specific spot.

[The constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' looks at incarnation 'Kyung Sein'.]

"No, hold the sword like this."

"Like this?"

"Stay still. I'll show you."

Jung Heewon was fixing the frozen Kyung Sein's posture.

Even from a distance, I could see that Kyung Sein's earlobes had turned bright red.

I had forgotten for a moment.

I had forgotten that her future attribute was the [Judge of Destruction].

[The constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' tilts her head.]

[The constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' makes a trial sponsorship of 100 coins to the incarnation 'Kyung Sein'.]

After receiving the coins, Kyung Sein's shoulders shook as if wondering what she was thinking.

"L-Like this? Is it okay?"

"Stretch your arm more, like this."

It was a sight that brought blood tears to my eyes, as I had sold my conscience and innocence to earn coins.

Holy constellation Gabriel.

The person you just sponsored is actually a muscular man. You're being deceived.

I stood up from my seat, thinking that I should tell my companions to go to Chungmuro.

And the next moment.

[The constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' calls her companion.]

My eyes widened at the sight of the name of the constellation entering the channel.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' has entered the channel.]

---

Author's Note

Hakhyun, do something

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 586 Episode 6. Star Relic (3)

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Demon-like Judge of Fire.

I was momentarily overcome with nostalgia at the sight of a modifier I hadn't seen in such a long time.

Archangel Uriel.

One of the 'four main constellations' of Bihyung's channel, along with the Prisoner of the Golden Headband, Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, and Secretive Plotter.

The constellation who loved the protagonist, Kim Dokja, more than any other.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' makes a sour face.]

However, without Kim Dokja, Uriel didn't seem to have any interest in the incarnations in this channel.

Perhaps that was Uriel's original self before she met Kim Dokja.

Kyung Sein, who had seen Uriel's entry message from afar, waved her hand in this direction. I saw the shape of her mouth.

'Hurry up and do something! She's here!'

That's what she seemed to be saying.

But what could I do?

Kim Dokja was born to be loved by all things, but I was Cheon Inho, one of the Ten Evils.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is looking at you.]

Even if she suddenly looked at me like that, I had nothing to show her.

Would you like to be incited?

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.4' is activated!]

「I am Kim Dokja.」

I tried to incite myself to become Kim Dokja.

But I couldn't feel any change, other than a couple of 'Ways of Survival' settings coming to mind.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is looking at you with strange eyes.]

Suddenly, I looked around and saw Dansoo ahjussi resting on the platform, probably tired from his kendo practice.

"Ahjussi."

"Mate."

For some reason, his expression was strangely dark.

"Are you okay?"

"Yes, I'm fine, but..."

He hesitated, but by now, I knew what he wanted to say without him speaking.

I was sure he was thinking about Jiyoon again.

Dansoo ahjussi smiled weakly and muttered as if to himself.

"If only I had liked a story that was a little less dangerous."

My heart suddenly felt heavy.

We sat side by side and stared into the darkness of the platform.

"Did your daughter always like novels?"

"She read them occasionally, but she especially liked this story."

"What did she like about this story?"

"That's....."

Ahjussi looked as serious as Yoo Joonghyuk contemplating a regression, and then answered in a serious voice.

"Probably that there are a lot of handsome characters."

"Ah..."

"My daughter once told me that she loved how those handsome companions kept saving each other."

I was left speechless and stared blankly into the darkness of the tunnel.

That's a pretty good summary.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is curious about what you are talking about.]

I could hear the people gathered on the platform laughing raucously.

Ahjussi spoke after a pause.

"I hope Jiyoon has friends like that by her side right now."

"I'm sure she does."

No amount of consolation would truly reach him right now.

Nevertheless, Dansoo ahjussi smiled faintly, gladly accepting my poor consolation.

"I'm so glad I met you, Inho-ssi. If you hadn't saved me back then, I would have been dead already."

"That's not true."

Dansoo ahjussi was the first reader I had met, which was probably why I wanted him to meet his daughter and return to reality safely.

I dusted myself off and stood up, extending my hand toward him.

"I'll do my best to save you until you meet your daughter."

Ahjussi, who clasped my hand and stood up, nodded and said.

"Yes. I'll do my best to help you too."

Seeing his warm smile, I felt my heart warm.

The next moment, I heard a message.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' has sponsored you 100 coins.]

I looked up into the air and thought.

.....Why did she sponsor me?

---

Just before leaving the station, we said goodbye to everyone.

Bang Cheolsoo, who came to see us off, was the first to speak.

"Hyung-nim. Are you leaving?"

"Yeah."

"Isn't it dangerous? It's better to see how things go from here and move together....."

"I have to go. Do you remember everything I told you?"

"Yes."

The 'food acquisition' scenario only gave 500 coins, which would only last five days if you paid your daily survival fee.

"If you want to escape the survival fee penalty, you'll have to move eventually. Finish the sub scenario as soon as you can, and get the people to Chungmuro. I'll take care of the monsters on the way."

"Hyung-nim....."

The members of the Cheoldoo Group bowed their heads towards me. I felt like I really was the boss of the organization.

Bang Cheolsoo spoke up.

"To be honest, I was suspicious of you at first."

"What do you mean?"

"You know, there's such a thing as people-watching. You looked a bit cowardly and had a sly smile."

"..."

"I still don't fully trust you. I've lived in the underworld for a long time, so I don't trust people."

Bang Cheolsoo, unlike himself, rambled for a long time.

"Still, watching you made me reflect on myself a bit. On what makes a person. You really shouldn't judge someone by their appearance..."

I was about to punch him in the head, but then I stopped. Don't judge a book by its cover...

I wondered if I deserved to hear that.

After all, I had judged Bang Cheolsoo based on a few lines from 'Omniscient Reader'. Then I suddenly had a strange thought.

How much truth does Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint contain?

"Okay. I'll see you again, so don't talk too much."

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' admires your noir vibe!]

[100 coins have been sponsored.]

"And this."

"And this.....?"

"It's the Magic Power Stove we used earlier. You take care of it and use it to cook."

The 'Magic Power Stove', the only cooking utensil here.

Bang Cheolsoo quickly understood what I meant by giving it to him.

"H-Hyung-nim....."

I turned my back on them.

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi had finished greeting the people and quickly joined me.

"Take care, hyung-nim!"

We walked through the chorus of the Cheoldoo Group and entered the Yaksu Station tunnel.

"What a bittersweet feeling."

Dansoo ahjussi kept looking back. Perhaps he had already gotten attached to the people.

Kyung Sein, who kept looking back at him, called out to me.

"Hey, Inho-ssi. By the way....."

I knew what she was going to say, so I simply replied.

"She'll be here soon."

Then I heard the sound of someone running after us. I didn't have to turn around to know who it was.

"I knew you'd come."

I turned around to see Jung Heewon standing there, pouting.

"Why didn't you ask me if I wanted to come with you?"

Instead of answering, I scanned our group. Two scrawny men and one girl with the soul of a muscular man.

Jung Heewon sighed heavily.

"Whatever, really."

"Thank you."

"It's not for free."

Jung Heewon hesitated, then added.

"You seem like a smart person, Inho-ssi, so I'm just trying to get some benefit by hanging out with you for a while."

"..."

"What are you looking at?"

"Nothing, I'm just a little moved."

"What moved..."

Jung Heewon pursed her lips and stared ahead, and for some reason, Kyung Sein looked at me with envy.

Dansoo ahjussi was walking a couple of steps away, looking at us with a warm smile.

Jung Heewon glanced over and asked to break the awkward silence.

"By the way, where are we going?"

The moment I heard that question, I suddenly had a question.

「How far can we really go?」

The darkness beyond the tunnel looked like a pitch-black snowfield.

Only Kim Dokja, who had read the entire story, knew what lay beyond.

"For now, let's go to Chungmuro."

It was time to meet the second member of <Kim Dokja's Company>.

**[Main Scenario #2 - Meeting]**

Category: Main

Difficulty: E

Clear Conditions: Cross the tunnel and meet the survivors in the first main base.

Time Limit: None

Reward: 500 coins

Failure: ???

[The next 'main base' is 'Chungmuro'.]

When we were about halfway through the tunnel, a new scenario window popped up.

The second scenario had finally begun in earnest.

We moved forward, lightly dealing with the occasional ground rats, and soon arrived at our first stop, Yaksu Station.

"I don't think there are any survivors here."

Just as it had been in the 3rd turn, Yaksu Station was empty in this one.

In the center of the platform, there were traces of corpses that had been collected and burned.

"Ugh, here..."

Through the scattered ashes and bits of clothing, I could see the words someone had written on the ground with charcoal.

—I miss my mom and dad.

Kyung Sein whispered.

"There wasn't anything like this in Omniscient Reader, right?"

I nodded.

Maybe it was left here by a reader.

Dansoo ahjussi stared at the words for an unusually long time.

After a quick check of the area, Jung Heewon said.

"It's all empty."

"Let's go straight to Dongdae Station, we'll rest there."

"Okay."

Jung Heewon took the lead, and we started moving again.

Kyung Sein whispered in a low voice.

"Inho-ssi, Dongdae Station..... You remember that?"

"Yes. I know."

After about thirty or forty minutes of walking, we finally arrived at the Dongdae Station platform.

There was no sign of life here either.

Perhaps because we had traveled through the two stops at a much faster pace than the original, Jung Heewon was a little tired.

"This is harder than I thought."

It was no wonder.

While passing through the two stations, she had single-handedly killed 150 ground rats.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is interested in the incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

This level of combat power without [Judgment Time] was phenomenal. At this rate, there shouldn't be any incarnation other than Yoo Joonghyuk who could defeat her.

"I'll take a break. I'll meet you here in 20 minutes."

"Is the restroom water still available? I'm just going to wash my face. Do you want to come with me, Sein?"

Kyung Sein shook her head in surprise. Jung Heewon nodded slightly and headed straight to the restroom.

"See you later, then."

After she disappeared, Kyung Sein and I glanced at each other.

"10 minutes should be enough, right?"

"5 minutes will do."

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is intrigued by your plan.]

Only Dansoo ahjussi, who had forgotten most of Omniscient Reader, looked puzzled, unable to understand our conversation.

---

A few moments later, we stood in front of Exit 6 of Dongdae Station.

[You have been exposed to a poisonous fog.]

We swallowed the Poison Rhino horn powder that remained after treating Killer King, then ran straight up the escalator leading to the exit.

"There it is!"

Kyung Sein was the first to spot our destination.

A bronze colored statue in the distance.

Dansoo ahjussi exclaimed as he realized.

惟政四溟大師像

Yujeong Samyeongdang.

It was unmistakable. It was the statue of Samyeongdang, whose modifier was 'Bald General of Justice' in the original story.

Here, Kim Dokja smashed this statue to get a hidden skill and an item.

"As expected, someone has already smashed it."

But the statue we found was already split in two.

[A constellation wearing a straw mat glares at you.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' chuckles at your misfortune.]

I smiled bitterly at the statue that had been cut exactly in half.

I didn't know who did it, but they had sliced it in half so neatly. Judging by the clean cut, it could have been Yoo Joonghyuk, Killer King, or some other reader.

The pale-faced Kyung Sein called out to me.

"Inho-ssi."

"I was expecting it."

"What?"

We weren't the only readers in this world.

There were people who had gone through a much more difficult ichthyosaur scenario than mine, people who couldn't get Broken Faith because of the queue, and people who had even had [Purest Sword Force] stolen from them.

So, naturally, I expected that someone would have claimed Samyeongdang's items first.

I slowly lifted the upper half of the statue from the ground.

[A constellation wearing a straw mat is puzzled by your actions.]

Still, with my level 20 strength, I could easily lift a weight that I normally wouldn't have been able to.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' has noticed your actions and is surprised.]

I pointed to the other side of the statue and said.

"Sein-ssi, could you please hold that for me?"

Kyung Sein hesitantly approached.

"L-Like this?"

"Yes. Lift it up to the top of your head like this."

"I'll try. Hop."

Together, we lifted the upper half of Samyeongdang's body above our heads.

While doing the scenario for a few days, I realized something.

You will never survive in this world by performing scenarios in the exact same way as in 'Omniscient Reader'.

"Dansoo ahjussi, get up on the stone and balance it!"

After a few minutes of struggle, we succeeded in barely balancing Samyeongdang's upper half back onto the lower half.

I cut off the clothes I'd brought in advance from Geumho Station and tied them tightly around the cracked area.

"There you go."

The statue looked like it had a bandage around its waist, but it still didn't look too bad.

Kyung Sein's mouth dropped open as she realized my intentions.

"Inho-ssi, this can't be....."

"Yes, that's right."

This world is the <Star Stream>.

A world where everything is a story.

You don't have to beat something up and break it to make a good story.

I smirked, looked at the two of them, and gave a short salute to the statue.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is deeply moved by your sincerity!]

As I looked up, I saw something shiny fall from the sky.

For the sake of future transmigrated readers, I'll kindly point it out.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is sponsoring you.]

This is how to survive in this damned <Star Stream>.

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Author's Note

Don't damage public property

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 587 Episode 6. Star Relic (4)

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A short while later, we descended into the subway and ate ground rat meat. This was to gain the 'contamination resistance effect' of the meat.

We had made ground rat jerky beforehand at Geumho Station, and it came in handy at times like this.

"What, are you eating alone?"

Jung Heewon, who had just returned from washing her face, took a big bite of the jerky I was holding and murmured,

"Did anything fun happen?"

"Why?"

"Because you all look like you're having fun."

"Hihihi."

Kyung Sein laughed strangely, and even Dansoo ahjussi had a subtle smile on his face.

I replied.

"We were doing some volunteer work."

"Volunteer work?"

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' praises the good deeds of the incarnations.]

Well, I wouldn't call it volunteer work, since we got paid.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' says that the spirit of the Korean Peninsula is not dead yet.]

At the constellation's sudden message, Jung Heewon stared at the air and tilted her head.

"Bald?"

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' warns her not to end that sentence.]

As it turned out, Jung Heewon was still unfamiliar with concepts like 'constellation' and 'incarnation'.

I briefly explained it.

"I understand roughly what a constellation is. It's like a god, right?"

"That's right."

"So that's why Inho-ssi and the others have repaired the bald..... god's statue?"

A disturbing spark fluttered over Jung Heewon's head, so I hastily added,

"He's not a bald god, he's the Bald General. His real name is Samyeongdang, and he was a great person in Korea. An excellent man."

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' calms down.]

"Samyeongdang is a Buddhist monk, right?"

Come to think of it, Jung Heewon didn't know much about Korean history.

I tried to think of a way to explain, but Kyung Sein replied instead.

"Samyeongdang was a monk in the middle of the Joseon Dynasty. During the Japanese Invasion of Korea, he defended the Korean Peninsula by leading monk soldiers against the Japanese troops."

Jung Heewon's eyes widened.

"Sein is smart."

"Hehe."

Kyung Sein winked at me.

In fact, her explanation was an imitation of Yoo Sangah's. It was a masterful response.

Jung Heewon asked,

"So these are all the items Samyeongdang gave you?"

I nodded.

"That's right."

Samyeongdang's 'sponsorship'. The shiny bag contained three items.

[Samyeongdang's Beads]

[Samyeongdang's Straw Mat]

[Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick]

'Samyeongdang's Beads' and 'Samyeongdang's Straw Mat' were items that also appeared in the 3rd turn. It was the last item, the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick', that was important.

**[Item Information]**

Name: Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick

Rating: Star Relic

Description: A star relic of the 'Bald General of Justice', a historical-grade constellation of the Korean Peninsula. Unfortunately, it has been damaged due to poor storage.

As an add-on, it increases Physique by 1 and Magic Power by 1, and provides a significant boost to magic resistance.

It can deal additional damage to ghost species and other heteromorphic monsters.

This time, I couldn't help but gasp.

I never thought I'd get another star relic.

An item that even Kim Dokja thought about but never actually got.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' shrugs it off.]

I suppose that meant our actions pleased Samyeongdang.

I didn't know who had broken the statue, but I was grateful.

"Let's distribute the items."

The first thing I picked up was the Samyeongdang's Straw Mat. In fact, the owner of this item had already been determined.

"Me? Why?"

Jung Heewon, who received the straw mat, asked, tilting her head.

"I just thought it would look good on you."

Kyung Sein, who was beside her, nodded enthusiastically.

Jung Heewon looked down at the item hesitantly, but then made up her mind and put on the straw mat.

This completed her initial setup in the 3rd turn, which included 'Samyeongdang's Straw Mat' and the 'ground rat knife'.

Kyung Sein was impressed and whispered to me.

"I never thought I'd get to see Heewon-nim's 'early setup' with my own eyes..."

As if sensing something, Jung Heewon glanced over suspiciously. We quickly clapped our hands and cheered.

"It looks good on you."

"Unni, you look great!"

Dansoo ahjussi, who had been standing still, chimed in.

"You look just like an outlaw in the wilderness."

"Really?"

Jung Heewon looked back and forth at her reflection in the screen door in disbelief.

For reference, when Kim Dokja saw that scene in the original, he commented.

「Actually, no matter how you look at it, it looks like a beggar's blanket.」

He may have written that, but he had probably been smiling. We watched Jung Heewon's excitement for a moment before deciding who would own the rest of the items.

We decided that Kyung Sein would get the 'Samyeongdang's Beads', which has magic resistance, while Dansoo ahjussi would get the 'Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick', which increases magic stats.

Kyung Sein asked in an apologetic voice.

"If you give them all to us, what about Inho-ssi?"

"I'm okay. I already have a star relic."

Dansoo ahjussi was overjoyed to have his first star relic, swinging the bamboo stick through the air. He even gave it a name.

"Wilson."

That was strange. I thought the bracelet was named Wilson.

---

After completing the preparations, we entered the tunnel heading straight for Chungmuro.

While Dansoo ahjussi used his [Diverse Communication] to sense danger ahead, Jung Heewon and Kyung Sein talked in hushed voices.

"It's creepy here. A ghost might come out. I think I hear strange cries, too..."

"Don't say that. You can't kill ghosts with a knife."

Come to think of it, it was about time for that 'monster' to come out.

Just as I was wondering if I should warn my companions, I heard a welcome message in my ear.

—This guy closes his eyes every time he sees me.

It was Bihyung's 'dokkaebi communication'.

I looked up and smirked.

'I haven't seen you much lately, so I closed my eyes.'

—Are you being sarcastic? I only just managed to find some free time. The number of kids doing weird stuff has dropped significantly.

The number had dropped significantly. Normally, this would be good news, but this time, it felt ominous. I had a feeling who those 'kids doing weird stuff' were.

—And the constellations' situation is weird too..... And what have you done to get cursed by the constellations? Some of them are targetting you these days.

Constellations that are after me?

—Shit, there they go again. I'm leaving.

With those words, Bihyung cut off the communication.

Since we had a stream contract, he must have checked in on me.

Regardless, the constellations were cursing me.

I had a feeling what kind of people they were.

I guessed it was the 'Plague-Carrying Rat' we fought earlier. Maybe more people from the Misreading Association had possessed constellations.

"Stop it. I really hate ghosts."

"Do I still look like Sein?"

The two were still talking about ghosts.

By now, we were more than halfway through the tunnel. It was time to get ready.

I unwrapped the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' from my wrist.

It was shaped like a bracelet now, but it had the ability to mimic any item it touched.

I opened the list of items that could be mimicked.

**[Possible Mimicry List]**

1. Magic Restoration Bracelet

2. Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick

.....

In preparation for this time, I put a few items on the mimicry list.

'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick' was a top-rated item, so it had a separate condition, but fortunately, the requirement was to 'have contact with the idea for at least 10 minutes', so I was able to meet it without any issues.

[You have selected 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick'.]

[The item is top-rated.]

[The item can be mimicked for 1 hour.]

One hour. That's more than enough.

The problem is.

['Thoughts of Almost Everything' refuses to mimic.]

This guy could refuse mimicry commands.

Two long, narrow eyes and a mouth appeared on the ring of the bracelet, emitting a small babbling sound.

"Si-jyo."

That was the only downside to the item ego, the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything'.

I couldn't transform it whenever I wanted.

Of course, I had a solution.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.4' is activated!]

"From now on, you are the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick'."

[Incite is effective!]

"Jyo—jyo!"

With a mystic light, the bracelet's form began to change.

['Thoughts of Almost Everything' has become 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick'.]

[The duration of the mimicry is 1 hour.]

Sure enough, it looked exactly like 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick'. The performance was the same.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is shocked!]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' asks if it's a scam.]

Surprised, Jung Heewon poked her head over my shoulder.

"Huh. That looks exactly like Dansoo ahjussi's bamboo stick?"

"I made it for you."

"What? For me?"

"I'm not giving it to you, I'm just lending it to you for a while."

Jung Heewon took the bamboo stick, swung it around, and tilted her head.

"It looks strong. But I have a knife already?"

"Hold on to that. You'll need it. You said earlier that you can't kill ghosts with a knife, but this can."

"What's wrong with you, Inho-ssi, really?"

"I'm not kidding, something is really about to come out. Hit everything you see with this."

In the original story, they had Kim Dokja and Lee Hyunsung to restrain her, but if Jung Heewon went on a rampage here, none of us would be able to stop her.

That was why the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick' with its magic resistance was a must-have for Jung Heewon.

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi already had a bad feeling about what lay ahead.

"Is everyone ready?"

Kyung Sein whispered as she shook the 'Samyeongdang's Beads' on her wrist.

"It's 'Phantom Prison' time now, isn't it? But what are you going to do, Inho-ssi? You don't have any magic resistance items."

"I don't need them."

"What?"

As soon as she spoke, something like a fog began to gather around us.

"Be careful, everyone. It's starting."

The final gateway before Chungmuro had finally begun.

[A new sub scenario has arrived!]

**[Sub Scenario — Phantom Prison]**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: D~F

Clear Conditions: Escape from Phantom Prison within the time limit.

Time Limit: 1 hour

Reward: 300 coins

Failure: ???

[Sub scenario — 'Phantom Prison' has begun!]

The rising fog quickly covered the tunnel.

My sense of space became disoriented, and Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi, who were right beside me, vanished.

I heard their voices from afar like hallucinations.

"Jiyoon?"

"U-uaaa!"

Phantom Prison is a space that touches the traumas of incarnations and leads them to madness.

Trapped in this fog, incarnations were forced to face their most horrific memories.

"Sein-ssi! Dansoo ahjussi! Heewon-ssi! Everyone, wake up, it's all an illusion!"

I shouted, but my voice only echoed hollowly through the fog.

The only reassuring thing was that everyone else in the group was wearing magic resistance items.

They would be panicking, but they should have no trouble escaping the Phantom Prison.

The problem was me.

I didn't have Samyeongdang's Beads or Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick.

I also lacked the [Fourth Wall] or the [破魔 (Destroy Evil)] skill like Kim Dokja in the original.

But I wasn't worried.

To be honest, I was almost curious to see what I would face.

['Phantom Prison' is experiencing a temporary error!]

Because I didn't have any memories that could be considered traumatic.

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Author's Note

Thanks.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 588 Episode 7. Trauma (1)

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Would the 'Phantom Prison' work on people without any 'trauma'?

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' wonders about your trauma.]

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is looking at you.]

Time passed, yet nothing appeared in front of me.

As expected, I didn't have any trauma.

I was born into a normal family, had a normal childhood, and grew up without any incidents.

Although the long period of being an unknown writer was difficult, it was not traumatizing.

I made enough money to put food on my table by helping professors with their chores, and I didn't skip meals even if I had to survive on triangular gimbap.

If you considered that hard, then there was nothing in the world that wasn't.

So if I didn't see anything here, it wouldn't be too strange.

It was then that I heard a voice through the fog.

「"There is no one without a trauma."」

The fog parted to reveal a classroom scene.

Fresh-faced freshmen sat in an oval formation. Some whose names I no longer remembered, others I still kept in touch with.

Among them was I, looking at the professor with a blank expression on my face.

「"Well, let's each share a story."」

With that, the professor sat down and pointed to a student.

The student stood up and immediately began to share their trauma.

「"When I was a kid, my homeroom teacher once told me that my diary was great and read it out loud in front of my friends."」

They sounded strangely proud.

As I listened, it slowly dawned on me what kind of class it was.

The creative writing program I attended had a famous freshman initiation ritual.

It was where freshmen were brought together and forced to confess their traumas.

It was a ridiculously violent event in retrospect, but at the time, some believed that such vulnerability was the path to true literature.

Clap clap clap clap.

When one person finished, another began to speak.

「"My trauma is....."」

All the misfortunes in the world seemed gathered there. You could call it a 'misfortune contest'.

My parents' divorce, the disappearance of a grandmother with dementia, my family going bankrupt and receiving a foreclosure notice, going to the police station for stealing a motorcycle, having my house burglarized while I was sleeping...

They were all in their early twenties, so how did they have so many experiences?

It was a mystery to me.

What was even more mysterious was the professor scribbling in his notebook as if grading their traumas.

Finally, it was my turn.

「"I....."」

I thought to myself.

What was the biggest misfortune, the most traumatic event that had happened to me?

Being chased by a dog as a child?

That's too weak.

Being put in supplementary classes because of low math scores?

It would just be a laughingstock.

I couldn't think of any plausible experiences. Compared to my peers, I had no story.

Story.

At that moment, an idea popped into my head. Taking a deep breath, I spoke the first sentence as if opening up a new universe.

「"I stabbed my father to death."」

Once I spoke the words, the story began to unfold.

I spoke about my mother, who loved books, and my father, who became violent whenever he drank.

I spoke about my mother protecting me from my father, about the broken bottle rolling across the floor, about how it felt when I first grabbed it, and about the sharp glass digging into my father's back.

The story was so vivid that I suddenly felt as if it had actually happened.

Maybe not here, but somewhere in the universe, a part of me had lived that life.

I was the one who started the story.

But when the story ended, I was part of it.

「"That's it."」

The room was now silent. The students stared at me blankly, without any comments, and the professor opened his mouth, having forgotten to grade me.

It didn't occur to me until then that I had made a huge mistake, and in my panic, I blurted out,

「"Oh, it's a lie."」

Maybe that was my trauma.

「That I have no trauma.」

After that fake trauma fiasco, my classmates made comments like this every time they read my writing.

「"It's another one of those stories that don't make sense."」

「"It's not sincere."」

I wondered what sincerity was.

Even after writing web novels for years, I still don't know what it is.

To put it bluntly, sincerity to me was something like the ghost standing before me now.

I smirked and approached the specter.

[The 8th-grade ghost species, 'Specter' looked at you.]

I swung my thorn with all my might. Since my opponent was a spirit, the hit damage was low, but the Specter's face was slightly distorted.

The dying Specter spoke to me.

「"I don't feel you in your novels."」

Why did people want to tell their stories so badly when there was nothing interesting about them?

「"A writer should have a personality of their own."」

Puhwak, a hole appeared in the Specter's face. Through the gaping hole, a pitch black darkness stared back at me.

「"You don't have any."」

I stared into the empty hole of the Specter.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' looks at you with pity.]

There was no need for pity. There was no reason for it.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier gives you a sad look.]

For in a world where nothing had happened, there was neither sorrow nor joy.

Splat!

Once again, the thorn struck the Specter, and it fell to the ground with a choked scream.

I grabbed the Specter by the nape of its neck and said,

"Don't die yet. There's someone I need to meet."

Then I leaned close to the hole in the Specter's face and called out a name.

I don't know if this will work or not.

But, if my guess is right.

—Who is it?

And after a moment.

I heard someone's voice through the fog.

—Yoo Joonghyuk? Is that you?

It was a voice I'd never heard.

—Are you.....?

But it was definitely a voice I knew.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.4' is activated!]

'I am Cheon Inho.'

I let go of the Specter's neck and stood up.

Through the hazy fog, a blonde foreign girl stared at me, her eyes wide with disbelief.

—It's you, 'The One Who Deceived the Stars'.

I nodded and opened my mouth to speak to her.

"Nice to meet you, Anna Croft."

> rlaehrwk61: Wow, so this is how they meet?
>
> rlaehrwk99: Come to think of it, it makes sense.

Yoo Joonghyuk said.

「"You must have met Anna Croft in the Chungmuro tunnel. You recalled the memories of the last turn..."」

The story gave me two hints.

One, there was a way to meet Anna Croft in the 'Chungmuro tunnel'.

Second, I could get the memories of the last turn from Anna Croft.

Anna Croft, who possessed [Past Sight], was the only person besides Yoo Joonghyuk who could obtain information about the previous turn.

Now that I was under suspicion from Yoo Joonghyuk, nothing could be better than hearing the details of the previous turn from Anna Croft.

It was for this very moment that I had faced the Specter without any magic resistance equipment or skills.

Just as Kim Dokja had, I used the 'Phantom Prison' mechanism to call out Anna Croft.

—How did you know my name? You can't possibly know it now.

"Yoo Joonghyuk told me about you."

—You've already met him?

"I met him by chance, though your reaction makes it seem like that wasn't supposed to happen."

Anna Croft's eyes shook slightly.

—He really does whatever he wants.

Looking at it, Anna Croft and Yoo Joonghyuk shared a connection.

I didn't know how these two former enemies had ended up working together, but now was the time to use what I had discovered.

"It's Yoo Joonghyuk, as usual. But I want to hear about it. What happened in the last turn? He said you would be able to tell me."

I tried to sound casual, but Anna Croft's eyes flared sharply.

—Last turn? What did you hear from Yoo Joonghyuk? How much do you know?

"Does it matter?"

—Answer.

[The character 'Anna Croft' has used 'Lie Detection Lv.6'!]

I sighed lightly.

This 'Lie Detection' thing.

"Did you forget that I can bypass 'Lie Detection'?"

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

Embarrassment flashed across Anna Croft's expression.

—You, how.....

"Let's not waste time fighting and get this over with. It doesn't matter who I heard it from. If you keep dawdling, I might change my mind. Right now, I'm here to help you, but in ten seconds, I might feel differently."

—.....You're going to help us? Are you serious?

I wondered if I'd said something wrong, but after a moment of silence, Anna Croft spoke up.

—Just before the end of the previous turn, Yoo Joonghyuk said that when I saw you in the 41st turn, I should show you your memories of the last turn.

As expected.

It was like that.

—To be honest, I had no intention of listening to him because I don't trust you.

"The villain is going to reform, so please help me."

—Cheon Inho, do you even know what you did in the previous turn?

"I don't know, I don't remember."

—I don't know what Yoo Joonghyuk is thinking. The two of you are just as bad...

Anna Croft sighed lightly.

The fog of the Phantom Prison was beginning to thin. There wasn't much time left.

"I'll ask you one last time. What happened in the previous turn? I need to know that much to decide if I'll help you."

Anna Croft hesitated for a moment, then spoke up, seemingly decided.

—Okay. If you want it so badly, I'll tell you.

"Be quick."

—I hope you have a shred of conscience left. I hope that when you see this story, you feel a fraction of that hellish pain.

As Anna Croft quietly closed one eye, I thought that this was not something the woman who had enslaved Yoo Joonghyuk in the 2nd turn would say.

[The character 'Anna Croft' has used 'Past Sight'.]

Past Sight. An unprecedented 'Prophet' OP skill that allowed you to glimpse your own memories from the last world line.

Tsuchuchuchut.

With a light spark, images and sensory information flowed into my head.

Acrid smoke made my eyes sting, and the heavy stench of blood made my head throb.

It didn't smell like the blood of just one or two people; it smelled like the blood of at least a thousand, turning the area into a crimson sea.

「"Are you satisfied?"」

A man stood in the center of the bloodbath.

A black coat and a sword stained with blood.

His entire body was stained with blood and dirt, but it didn't dull the glow in his eyes.

I looked up at the polar-night sky. I could barely see any stars. From somewhere, the cry of a dragon echoed.

「"You don't know what you have done."」

As if counting the few stars left, the man said in a calm voice.

「"You will never know what you have ruined, what doom you have brought."」

Anger at its peak, reduced to ash.

The emptiness and heartbreak in his voice.

My heart sank just listening to it.

「As always, he was a man who had walked through everything on his own all his life.」

Suddenly, the clouds parted, and a faint starlight illuminated his face.

「Yoo Joonghyuk, the Supreme King of the 40th turn, was there.」

Yoo Joonghyuk dropped his gaze and looked at someone.

A man stood opposite him, unperturbed by the overwhelming momentum of the Supreme King.

A blackish red coat fluttered in the ruins.

Black wings stretched out from the coat.

For a moment, my heart throbbed.

Because I thought he might be Kim Dokja.

「"That's a funny expression, Yoo Joonghyuk. I've already failed this turn, I should start over. Is that the face you make when you think about that?"」

But the voice wasn't Kim Dokja's.

「"That would be convenient. You can always press the reset button and start everything from scratch."」

The owner of the voice was laughing.

「"But remember. No master craftsman can make two identical dolls. The moment you press the reset button, the world doesn't just disappear, it becomes eternal."」

As if mocking everything in the world, the man continued.

「"This world will always be ruined, and I will forever remain in the deepest recesses of your memory as an immortal nightmare."」

Though he wore a pure white half-mask, it was not difficult to recognize his face.

It was not hard to recognize his face, for it was the face I faced when I first stepped into this world.

「"Now, go ahead and reset everything. Struggle and die a slow death, flailing in eternal nightmares, you damn regressor."」

And there was the 40th turn Cheon Inho.

Author's Note

Thank you for reading today.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 589 Episode 7. Trauma (2)

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I couldn't believe it.

I couldn't believe that's really the 'Cheon Inho' I know.

「"If you won't end it."」

Cheon Inho's figure, that was standing on a blood tomb, disappeared.

「"I will."」

Wings of pitch black feathers spread from his back. And the next moment.

[The story 'When All the Stars Close Their Eyes' has begun its storytelling.]

I felt goosebumps.

'Cheon Inho' used a story.

What on earth had happened, what had he eaten to grow up this much, to make him so strong at the 40th turn?

Kookookookookoo.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who grabbed the Splitting the Sky Sword, looked around. But there was no sign of Cheon Inho.

There was only pitch blackness around him. No starlight could illuminate Cheon Inho's figure.

There was no sign of him, no smell.

「It was as if Yoo Joonghyuk was alone.」

At that moment, something invisible slashed Yoo Joonghyuk's cheek, then his forearm, then his thigh.

Blood spurted everywhere, as if he was playing with him.

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't fight back, but waited, holding the Splitting the Sky Sword.

I watched the battle with sweaty hands.

Neither his five senses nor my vision could detect the figure of Cheon Inho.

But Yoo Joonghyuk's growing wounds spoke for themselves.

Cheon Inho is here.

Yoo Joonghyuk used the [Red Phoenix Shunpo] to start his movements. Cheon Inho's attacks became faster. The number of wounds quickly increased.

Shoulders, thighs, neck, calves.

But there were no fatal wounds.

Every time a blow touched his skin, Yoo Joonghyuk was controlling the depth of the wound with an amazing technique. It was almost a miracle.

Very slowly, Yoo Joonghyuk's lips opened.

「"Open your eyes."」

And then,

[The story 'The King Who Leads the Stars' has begun its storytelling.]

The unbelievable happened.

「"Open your eyes, damn constellations."」

With Yoo Joonghyuk's words, the stars in the far reaches of the night sky began to shine. The world's few remaining stars were burning themselves to create light.

[The constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' is looking at the incarnation of Yoo Joonghyuk.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is looking at the incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk.]

[The constellation 'Guardian of Youths and Travel' is looking at the incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk.]

Gabriel, Uriel and Raphael, the stars of <Eden> were shining.

But their light was not enough to dispel the darkness.

Still, Yoo Joonghyuk said.

「"It's enough."」

For a moment, the uniform darkness shook in disparate ways, and an aggressive energy boiled through Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

The slash on his side and the movement of his Splitting the Sky Sword happened at the same time.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship (破天劍道).

Destruction Technique (絶技).

Breaking the Sky Meteor Strike (破天流星決).

The sword force[1] that could split the night enveloped the tip of Splitting the Sky Sword's blade.

[NOTE 1]

Bright light cut through the darkness, and Splitting the Sky Sword slashed at something.

The blood bursting sound could be heard in the air, and for a moment, Cheon Inho's figure, who grabbed his chest, was revealed.

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't miss the opportunity to strike at Cheon Inho's abdomen.

Breaking the Sky Force Punch (破天崩拳).

Third Form (第三式).

Thousand Autumns Phoenix (千秋鳳凰).

A brilliant flame wrapped around Yoo Joonghyuk's fist, and an eardrum-bursting roar exploded from Cheon Inho's abdomen, sending him flying, his body hit a pile of ruins.

Tsuchuchuchut.

Next, the stars in the sky began to extinguish one by one.

The stars that lit up the night sky, fueling all his stories, were dying.

Raphael's star was the first to go, followed by Gabriel's.

The last one was Uriel.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' pays homage to incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk.]

Yoo Joonghyuk stared at the spot where Uriel's star had disappeared for a long time, and then muttered in a low voice as if talking to them.

「"I'm sorry."」

It was unbelievable.

Yoo Joonghyuk hated the constellations of the night sky more than anyone else in the world. In particular, before he met Kim Dokja, he was the embodiment of vengeance who would not stop regressing until he had knocked out every star in the sky.

And yet, he apologized to the constellations.

My head was spinning, I didn't understand what was going on.

Was this story in the 40th turn of 'Ways of Survival'?

If such a story existed, there's no way Kim Dokja wouldn't have known about it.

At that moment, the question arose for the first time.

「Did 'Ways of Survival' really record all of Yoo Joonghyuk's regressions?」

According to Kim Dokja's narration, yes.

Regressions where Yoo Joonghyuk went crazy and gave up quickly were gradually omitted, but there were no regressions that were not recorded in the 'Ways of Survival'.

Then what is this view I'm looking at.

In Kim Dokja's recollections, Yoo Joonghyuk was not this strong in the early rounds. It took at least hundreds of regressions for him to become strong enough to kill the constellations.

However, in the 40th turn, he seemed to be stronger than even the narrative-grade constellations in the sky.

Not only was Yoo Joonghyuk stronger, but so was Cheon Inho.

Spreading his demonic wings and using the power of stories freely.

There was no way that the meticulous Kim Dokja, who had memorized every single one of the 1,863 turns of Ways of Survival, could not have remembered Cheon Inho like that.

If Kim Dokja knew, he would have thought of the 40th turn Cheon Inho as soon as he saw him.

Therefore, there is only one reasonable explanation to this whole situation.

There is a world that Kim Dokja has not read.

「There are world lines that are not written in 'Ways of Survival'.」

But how?

It was like a big bang in my head, like the moment when I thought of the false trauma.

「In the '41st turn', Yoo Joonghyuk sent Shin Yooseung to the past world line, and Shin Yooseung became the 'Disaster of Floods'.」

The moment that thought popped into my head, I remembered the snowy landscape that I had walked with Kim Dokja.

「'Ways of Survival' is the story of Yoo Joonghyuk after he turned Shin Yooseung into the 'Disaster of Floods'.」

In the snowy field where I had walked with Kim Dokja, the footprints split in two.

「Then, where is the story of Shin Yooseung before she became the 'Disaster of Floods' written down?」

There were two footprints, one that went on indefinitely, and one that disappeared in the middle.

「The story of the 41st turn with Yoo Joonghyuk before Shin Yooseung became the 'Disaster of Floods'.」

The story remained only a brief flashback in 'Ways of Survival'.

It wasn't even properly recorded in the 'Ways of Survival'.

If I'm looking at the memories of that world right now.

「"Stop pretending, Cheon Inho, I know you're alive."」

At those words, Cheon Inho rose from the pile of ruins.

「"Now you've lost even your last colleague, Yoo Joonghyuk."
"....."
"No star is watching over you anymore."」

Two swords clashed in the air.

One was Yoo Joonghyuk's Splitting the Sky Sword. The other.

「"Black Heavenly Demon Sword, you have been in Murim."
"Not only in Murim."」

The black imprints on Cheon Inho's neck and the backs of his hands were smeared like blood.

Demon Force (魔氣).

Cheon Inho was using demonic energy.

The energy that enveloped the Black Heavenly Demon Sword formed into sword force, which then crashed down on Yoo Joonghyuk.

In response, Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body turned golden.

Transcendent Form (超越形).

Kookookookookoo!

It was a bloody battle.

Cheon Inho's and Yoo Joonghyuk's magical powers intermittently burned the darkness, and the blazing stories bit into each other's flesh.

Covered in blood, Yoo Joonghyuk shouted, and Cheon Inho's left arm flew through the air. Next, Cheon Inho's sword pierced Yoo Joonghyuk's side.

Finally, all the light around them disappeared. The two men's magic power was completely exhausted.

No stars shone upon them. No stories recorded their battle.

「Only I could imagine their fight in this darkness.」

A full night. Two men were fighting. Something was slashed, something was torn.

They didn't stop. The sound of stabbing and slashing echoed through the blackness of no conversation.

Blood dripping, blades breaking, and then,

the sound of someone falling.

「"Are you satisfied now?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk asked.

「"Satisfied with what?"」

Cheon Inho replied.

The sound of someone falling was heard once more.

「"With ruining this world."」

Silence followed.

The hard breathing of the two men echoed intermittently.

A voice spoke again.

「"I should have killed you the first time I saw you."
"But you didn't."
"It was a mistake."
"Did you kill them all in the other turns?"
"I did."
"Then I've succeeded in avenging the last turn. Though I don't remember it anyway."」

I heard the sound of blood dripping out. It was impossible to tell whose blood it was.

「"I never asked you before."
"What do you mean?"
"Why you live the way you do."」

A laugh of disbelief.

「"I just lived hard. I've only lived a little longer this time."
"Honestly, I was surprised this time. I didn't think you'd take on all the Ten Evils."
"You underestimated the capabilities of this body."
"I admit it."
"You should have had me as a colleague sooner."」

They fought and fought and fought, finally reaching the end of this terrible war.

It was only at this moment that Cheon Inho's joke was possible.

Because he had fought as hard as he could.

And because they both realized that this moment was the end of this world.

After a pause, Yoo Joonghyuk's serious voice continued.

「"I should have. But it's too late for this life."」

A muffled laugh echoed in the darkness.

「"Do you mean to say that in your next life, you will have me as a colleague? The body of the Ten Evil, Evil Sophist, your arch enemy?"
"....."
"Why don't you answer me, Yoo Joonghyuk?"
"That wasn't enough to be my arch enemy."」

After a short silence, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke.

「"If the world were to repeat itself once more, would you be willing to live a different life?"」

Cheon Inho was speechless for a long time.

Just as I wondered if he was dead, the voice continued.

「"Are you serious? I killed your colleagues."
"I know."
"And you still want me as one of your colleagues?"
"Not quite a colleague, but close."
"......Are you out of your mind?"」

Cheon Inho's voice was filled with hatred for Yoo Joonghyuk and grief for this world.

「"Why would you need my help? You can repeat the world infinitely anyway. No matter how difficult the scenario is, if you try again and again, you'll eventually clear it."
"....."
"Don't think of making me your colleague. I will be your enemy in the next turn, and I will be your enemy again, and again, and again."」

As he spoke, Chen Inho's breathing became weaker and weaker. Little by little, his physical strength was declining.

「"Hurry up and press the reset button. Face me as an enemy forever."」

There are heroes and there are villains.

Cheon Inho chose the path of the villain.

He dismissed all the possibilities and declared that he would become a clown, a villain who was constantly resurrected.

Then the hero asked.

「"Why do you think resets are infinite?"」

I heard someone inhale. Maybe it was my breath.

「"Cheon Inho."」

For a moment, a nameless star twinkled somewhere in the deep night sky.

The moon, which had been hidden in the darkness, received the light and illuminated the ground once more.

「"I can only press the reset button once now."」

A chill ran down my spine.

In the dusky moonlight, Yoo Joonghyuk was looking this way.

He seemed to be speaking to me across a distant world line.

「"In the next turn, everything in this universe will be destroyed permanently."」

---

Author's Note

Thank you.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: 검강(劍罡) is a martial arts term which roughly translates to 'high level swordsmanship' that is used by martial artists in Chinese fantasy novels. They are even capable of using their bodies as weapons. '검강' is basically of stronger version of 검기 ("aura of a sword; sword aura; sword energy"). (Explanation from Hardcore Leveling Warrior fandom wiki)

# 590 Episode 7. Trauma (3)

---

The 'next turn' that Yoo Joonghyuk was referring to was the one I was currently in.

「41st turn.」

Yoo Joonghyuk said.

In this turn, everything in the universe will be destroyed permanently.

My heart raced.

What the hell does that mean?

I couldn't stop thinking about the disconnected footprints in the middle of the snowfield.

[Your mental state is extremely unstable!]

['Incite' is shaking.]

With a light spark, the memory became noisy.

My normal vision scattered, and before I knew it, Anna Croft was standing in front of me.

「Who.....」

The Great Demon's Eye glowed in one of her glaring pupils. Something went wrong.

「.....are you?」

I was caught off guard. The power of the [Incite] had weakened, and my disguise as Cheon Inho had been shattered.

「You're..... You're not Cheon Inho.」

The fog around me started to disperse faster.

The moment Anna Croft reached out to me with an urgent look on her face.

「Anna, stop coming around.」

Along with the unfamiliar voice, I heard the snap of someone's fingers, and with that sound, my vision went black for a moment. And then.

Peok.

Something hit me in the back of the head. I turned around in dizzying pain, and there stood a woman holding the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick'.

"Huh? Inho-ssi?"

It was Jung Heewon.

---

It was an unheard choice to give the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick' which was cloned with the 'Idea' to Jung Heewon.

She was the only one of the group who didn't fall into the 'Phantom Prison'.

"The monsters were a little weird. They didn't attack me, they just stared at me....."

"What did you do?"

"I got creeped out, so I closed my eyes and swung at them, and they stopped....."

I looked down at the crumpled Specter and sighed. Jung Heewon scolded me.

"You could have told me more beforehand."

It would have been nice, but I hated the fact that the moment I told her, I would have to explain why I knew that.

Once again, I felt the wisdom of Kim Dokja's words.

"I didn't know for sure either. What about the others?"

"I laid them over there."

I turned my head and saw Dansoo ahjussi stretched out and Kyung Sein curled up in a ball.

"It's been like that since earlier."

I was surprised. Dansoo ahjussi was holding the original copy of the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick', and Kyungsein was holding 'Samyeongdang's Beads'.

Even though I gave them each an item with magic resistance, it wasn't enough.

Still reeling from the shock of their Phantom Prison, Dansoo ahjussi grunted like a sick man, while Kyung Sein crouched down and repeatedly asked not to hit her.

I sat next to them and wiped their sweaty foreheads.

Kyung Sein and Lee Dansoo.

These were the people who proved their 'value' in the infamous first scenario.

They weren't afraid to look at the corpses of people, and they fought bravely against those terrifying ground rats.

Maybe that's why I vaguely thought they would be okay.

「They're just ordinary readers.」

It wasn't the monsters nor the killing, it was the reality they lived in that brought down those two who stood up to the scenarios.

「Ordinary people who were unfortunate enough to be transmigrated into this world.」

I felt my heart grow cold again.

What was I going to do with them? Was I going to raise them, soothe them, train them, and take them on some exciting adventure?

Kyung Sein slowly opened her eyes and looked up at me.

"U-uuh.....?"

He[1] sat up shakily and looked around anxiously.

[NOTE 1]

It was as if her tormentor was still lurking somewhere in the darkness.

I patted her on the back and said.

"Sein-ssi, we've got all the Specters. We've recovered the Specter's Stones. You're safe now, just breathe slowly."

Kyung Sein, who was breathing heavily, let out a slightly sobbing voice.

"Inho-ssi....."

"Yes."

"Kim Dokja..... went through something like this. He overcame something like this."

Clearly, Kim Dokja is a great person. The more time I spend in this world, the more I realize that.

"You overcame it too, Sein-ssi."

Kyung Sein shook her head helplessly and asked.

"Are you okay, Inho-ssi?"

"Fortunately."

"How did..... Do you really have a 'Fourth Wall' or something?"

"It's just that my life didn't have many ups and downs. Ahjussi, are you awake?"

Checking my face, Dansoo ahjussi burst into tears.

"Alive."

I don't know what he was dreaming about, but he grabbed my arm and wiped the tears away.

"Hurry up..... Let's go to the next station."

I don't know what he was dreaming about.

But I know what he wanted to find in this world when he woke up.

"We're almost in Chungmuro. You'll find her soon enough."

Going to Chongmuro would start the third scenario, and once that was over, we would be able to interact with the other stations in earnest.

We'll find out Jiyoon's news soon enough.

"Don't worry, I'll find her no matter what."

Ahjussi nodded weakly.

"Then let's get moving."

As I helped Dansoo ahjussi to his feet, Jung Heewon also helped Kyung Sein up.

Jung Heewon asked.

"Will it be okay? We should let them rest a little longer....."

"It's better to rest when we get to the station. The tunnel is dangerous."

After only three stops, the two were exhausted.

Jung Heewon, who was walking beside me, asked in a small voice.

"Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"You're not overdoing it, are you?"

"No."

Dansoo ahjussi's arms were damp with cold sweat.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' looks at the group worriedly.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' cheers you on.]

Some readers may have encountered Specter in other regions.

I wonder if they survived.

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' watches you.]

If they died somewhere in this world, whose fault were their deaths?

Whoever brought them into this world's? Or—

「"There is no way such a villain exists in this world."」

I felt faintly dizzy, and I could smell blood somewhere.

Was this another Specter?

Or did I never escape from the 'Phantom Prison'?

"Wait. There's something..... wrong."

Dansoo ahjussi said hesitantly.

There was a squishy feeling on my toes. When the smartphone's flash lit up on the floor, it revealed a bloody railroad track. Strewn about were the bodies of neither man nor monster.

"Ugh."

Kyung Sein held back her nausea and raised her shield, while Jung Heewon's expression hardened and she grabbed the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick' that was made with the 'Idea'.

But there was no sign of [■■] being triggered yet.

If the situation was truly dangerous, the color of the world would have changed first.

"Let's move forward slowly. It's not too bad yet."

I took the lead and began to move forward, clearing the railroad tracks.

Some of the dead outer species on the ground looked familiar. They resembled the Ratmen we'd encountered in the 'Edge of Darkness'. There were also some that resembled the reptilian creatures Bang Cheolsoo had mentioned.

There must have been some kind of war for so many of them to die at once.

Most of the bodies bore bullet holes.

"Mate."

Dansoo ahjussi called out to me.

A light was shining some distance away.

"Ugh, there."

As Kyung Sein spoke, a girl doll was seen under the dim light.

Long hair on a ponytail.

"Ah....."

The moment Kyung Sein saw her, she stopped dead in his tracks, as if she'd been electrocuted.

And for good reason.

Running into that little girl was proof that we had finally arrived at Chungmuro.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated.]

**[Character Summary]**

Name: Lee Jihye

Age: 17 years old

Sponsor: Maritime War God (海上戰神)

Exclusive Attributes: Scarred Sword Demon (Rare)

Exclusive Skills: [Sword Training Lv.3], [Demon Slaying Lv.1], [Absolute Sense Lv.3], [Ghost Walk Lv.1]

Stigma: [Sea Battle Lv.1], [Large Army Command Lv.1]

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.16], [Strength Lv.15], [Agility Lv.16], [Magic Power Lv.11]

Overall Evaluation: A person who evolved into a 'Scarred Sword Demon' after killing her closest friend. The sponsor behind her doubts you.

* 'Starter Pack' is currently applied.

The second <Kim Dokja's Company> member I meet in the 41st turn.

Yoo Joonghyuk's first sword, and the incarnation of Maritime War God Yi Sunsin.

The only survivor of Daepong Girls' High School, Lee Jihye.

Wearing her trademark hood zipped-up, she stamped her foot on the railroad tracks and looked toward Chungmuro Station.

Jung Heewon whispered.

"Do you know her?"

Not yet.

If I had to say something.

"She's the disciple of a bastard I know."

It was then that the indirect message came to mind.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is touched at meeting an old companion.]

I realized that the same message was in the main story of Omniscient Reader.

The problem was the message that came back.

[Lee Jihye's sponsor warns the 'Bald General of Justice' to go back quickly because it's dangerous here.]

Dangerous?

[Main Scenario #2 - Meeting has ended.]

[The compensation will be settled.]

I tossed the reward message aside and looked back at the group.

"I'll take the lead."

Neither Kyung Sein nor Dansoo ahjussi were in any condition to fight.

For now, I must take the lead.

Just then, Lee Jihye, who was crossing her arms in the distance, looked over.

"Oh? What's that?"

Lee Jihye gripped the hilt of her sword, and Jung Heewon stepped forward as if to protect me.

I approached with both my hands raised to show that I meant no hostility.

"Hello. We're from Geumho Station."

"You can't go through here, so go back."

Look at that.

Another twist from the original.

"We have no ill intentions. We'd like to join Chungmuro. Can you please accept us?"

At this point, Chungmuro would be in the middle of the third scenario, 'Green Zone'.

'Green Zone' is a scenario in which you must occupy a 'Green Zone' on the station or be hunted by monsters every night.

Since Lee Jihye is a rival of Gong Pildu, the ruler of Chungmuro Station, there was no reason for her to stop us.

"Master told me not to let anyone come here."

Yoo Joonghyuk?

"Is Yoo Joonghyuk in Chungmuro?"

"Do you know my Master?"

"I do."

"Then why didn't you say so earlier?"

As Lee Jihye's eyes widened, she smiled and took a step closer.

"Master told me to kill all the bastards who knew him."

"Heewon-ssi!"

At the same time I shouted Jung Heewon's name instinctively, Lee Jihye's figure disappeared.

Kagagagak!

Jung Heewon's ground rat knife, which was imbued with [Kendo], accurately stopped Lee Jihye's [Sword Training].

Surprised, Lee Jihye muttered.

"Wow, look at this unni."

Despite the fact that Jung Heewon's overall stats were higher than in the original, Lee Jihye and Jung Heewon were still neck and neck.

This meant that Lee Jihye was also stronger than at the same point in the original.

"Heewon-ssi! Buy me a few minutes! Please!"

At my shout, Jung Heewon threw something at me.

"Take this!"

It was the 'Damaged Samyeondang's Bamboo Stick' made by the 'Idea'.

I quickly snatched up the Bamboo Stick and said to the two people behind me.

"Stay here for a moment."

As I passed by, Lee Jihye shouted in a sharp voice.

"Hey! Stop!"

According to the original, Chungmuro is currently on Day 2 of the 'Green Zone' scenario.

It wasn't odd for Yoo Joonghyuk to be in Chungmuro.

The problem is that this is the unrivaled 41st turn Yoo Joonghyuk.

I could hear a light explosion coming from Chungmuro Station.

I sped up my pace, shrugging off the ominous premonition. A dozen steps later, the Chungmuro platform came into view.

The first thing I saw was a large hole in the center of the platform floor, and people hiding in the stairwells and other places.

The terrified citizens were all looking at the two men who were fighting on the hole in the platform.

One, needless to say, was Yoo Joonghyuk.

The problem was the person on the other side.

"Damn you. How dare you cross my land?"

You know the drill.

The short-tempered Yoo Joonghyuk has gotten into a fight with Gong Pildu.

Fortunately, the fight doesn't seem to be a full-fledged fight yet, so there's still hope.

"Ahjussi, kill him quickly."

A boy's voice came from behind Gong Pildu.

At the same time, Gong Pildu nodded.

"Yes. I was about to."

I wondered if he's already made this area his [Private Property]. Mini-turrets rose from his [Armed Zone] all at once.

Seven turrets in total.

It was two more than in the 3rd turn of Omniscient Reader.

But that's not enough to stop Yoo Joonghyuk.

Kooooo.

This is because in the 40th turn, Yoo Joonghyuk is a monster that has already surpassed the narrative-grade constellations.

The moment he holds the spear, Gong Pildu will certainly die.

[The character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' wants to do something unexpected].

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '■■' has been met.]

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

Luckily, the 'Snowfield' was triggered.

In the image that went colorless, the mini-turret began charging, and Yoo Joonghyuk held the spear handle in his hand.

It was a close call.

I have to change the story somehow.

But.

[You have an absurdly low understanding of that character.]

[You can't intervene in the character's actions.]

Damn it.

I've seen this message before.

A few days ago, when the poisonous rhinoceros appeared, I entered the Snowfield, apparently because of that 'Yoo Joonghyuk's unexpected behavior.

Back then and now, I couldn't write a sentence.

I don't know what kind of person Yoo Joonghyuk is in the 41st turn.

All I know is that he was portrayed as an extremely vicious being in 'Ways of Survival'.....

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

I checked the feedback.

> rlaehrwk99: But is the 41st turn Yoo Joonghyuk really that bad?
>
> rlaehrwk37: There is no such thing as a bad Yoo Joonghyuk in the world.

And the moment I read that comment.

[Your understanding of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has increased slightly.]

Something strange happened.

---

Author's Note

There's no such thing as a bad person who eats soil

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

Note [1]: Basically, they almost never use pronouns in Korean so until now Lee Hakhyun only called her by her name when talking about her or didn't use any pronouns. In this sentence, he used "he". Since he normally refers to her as a girl or only says she has a muscular man soul, and Kyung Sein didn't have any problems using female specific terms either, like calling Jung Heewon, I'll leave it as she/her.

# 591 Episode 8. Representative Kim Dokja (1)

---

My understanding of Yoo Joonghyuk has increased. It wasn't hard to find the reason.

Perhaps the comments left by kkoma Kim Dokjas had some kind of influence on me.

「Is the 41st turn Yoo Joonghyuk really a bad guy?」

The moment I heard those words, it was like hundreds of circuits in my head lit up at once.

「"I lost a bad shield."」

「"In the future, sea battles will be a bit difficult."」

In my head, the lines I had written for Yoo Joonghyuk popped up. In those lines, he was more of a villain than a good guy.

Moreover, Shin Yoosung from the 41st turn had also expressed her deep disappointment in Yoo Joonghyuk.

But what was the Yoo Joonghyuk I peeked at in the theater of my dream like?

「"The marginalized group can come out in peace. I'll show you how to get food from now on."」

And what about the 40th turn Yoo Joonghyuk I saw through Anna Croft?

「"If the world were to repeat itself once more, would you be willing to live a different life?"」

Can I really categorize Yoo Joonghyuk as a 'villain'?

In the slow-moving time of the Snowfield, I acknowledged that the words I read and wrote were only a part of the life Yoo Joonghyuk lived. This is especially true for the 41st turn Yoo Joonghyuk.

There was only one sentence I could write about him now.

「I don't know Yoo Joonghyuk.」

[Your understanding of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has increased slightly.]

[You are now able to write about the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

I checked the window in front of me, like checking the first footprints in the Snowfield.

> # Protagonist's Choice
>
> 「At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk ■■.....」
>
> * At your current skill level, you can write a total of 20 additional characters.

Only 20 characters.

That was all I could write about 'Yoo Joonghyuk' at the moment.

[Your understanding of the character is low.]

[The number of times you can describe this scene is limited.]

[You can only describe the scene once.]

I only had one chance.

I calmly closed my eyes and thought about the Yoo Joonghyuk I had seen with my own eyes.

The version closest to the current Yoo Joonghyuk was the Yoo Joonghyuk I saw in the 40th turn in the 'Phantom Prison', and the Yoo Joonghyuk who left two 'Elaine Forest Essence' beads at Geumho Station.

[Your understanding of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has increased slightly.]

I thought.

[Your understanding of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has increased slightly.]

I thought again.

20 characters. Barely enough to describe a single line of character behavior.

In those 20 characters, what can I express about Yoo Joonghyuk?

I often had this problem when I was writing Omniscient Reader—when I couldn't write the right line or action for a character.

「"Just write it."」

At such times, Ji Eunyu would say.

「"Trust the characters who have lived in the world you created, and just write it."」

Once again, all I could do was helplessly believe her words.

「Believe in Yoo Joonghyuk, who has lived in this world.」

I wrote a sentence for him.

It wasn't much, really.

But that one line was all I understood about him and all I could give him now.

[This story is plausible.]

[This story's reproduction success rate is 93%.]

[There's enough probability.]

[Do you want to check the reader's feedback?]

> rlaehrwk37: Yoo Joonghyuk is Yoo Joonghyuk

I read that feedback wordlessly. I couldn't tell from the feedback whether this 'reproduction' would be successful or not.

All I can say now is that I'm on the same page as KimDokja37.

[Successfully recreating the scene.]

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

The colorless time scattered. The guns of the mini-turrets were about to fire.

「At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk put down the spear.」

The faint spark in Yoo Joonghyuk's right hand was the effect of my sentence.

However, when he released the spear from his hand, he looked confused. He didn't understand why he suddenly did what he did.

From here, it was up to Yoo Joonghyuk.

The Yoo Joonghyuk I saw. The unfortunate protagonist who wanted to save the world, even by joining hands with a villain.

「In fact, Yoo Joonghyuk knew. He knew that he shouldn't kill Gong Pildu right now.」

「Because this would be his last turn.」

"Die."

The mini-turrets that had finished charging spewed out fire. It was a shell that even the Steel Sword Lee Hyunsung had trouble blocking. Even if Yoo Joonghyuk was a monster who slaughtered a 7th grade monster species, there was no way he would be safe if he was hit by a series of turrets like that.

「Seven turrets in total. If they all hit at the same time, even Yoo Joonghyuk will be in danger.」

But Yoo Joonghyuk didn't move. He didn't even hold his spear.

His expression was one of deep confusion. Maybe it was the sentence I wrote that shook his judgment.

But that was enough, Yoo Joonghyuk already did his part.

Then, this time,

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 4' has been activated!]

It was my turn to take responsibility for my words.

「Turn into an 'Old Iron Shield'.」

At the same time as I used Incite, 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' glowed.

When Yoo Joonghyuk looked up, the shells were already in front of him.

Kwaaaaang!

I blocked Yoo Joonghyuk's way by a hair's breadth. The impact felt like it would shatter my shield.

But I held on.

I was able to hold on.

Because my strength level was now higher than Lee Hyunsung's.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Wise decision. You must never kill Gong Pildu to achieve what you want."

When I glanced back, Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at me in surprise.

"Why are you looking at me like that? You said we'd be on the same side sometime."

I don't know what the 41st turn Yoo Joonghyuk will go through in the future.

I don't know what tragedy he's been through, what despair he's been through, or how he's come to this conclusion.

But I can see it in his face now.

「This world may not end in tragedy.」

I smirked at Yoo Joonghyuk, ending the conversation.

"I'll show you how I was able to make the Ten Evils my allies."

---

Kwaaaaang!

A distant bang. Watching Cheon Inho take the shells, the woman in the white coat frowned in the darkness.

She bit the lemon candy in her mouth and muttered.

"The more I look at him, the crazier he is."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' chuckles.]

"What did he think he was doing, running right up to him? Did he forget that he's Cheon Inho?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says he misses him.]

The woman pursed her lips for a long time at those words, and then muttered through her teeth.

"......I don't miss him one bit."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says he never said he missed him.]

"Shut up."

---

My sudden entry caused a lull in the station.

Luckily, Yoo Joonghyuk stepped back as if to observe.

In the distance, Lee Jihye and the others were looking at me with wide eyes.

I was at my limit, guys.

Of course, they weren't the only ones who were surprised.

"You..... What?"

Gong Pildu asked, and I replied.

"I'm Cheon Inho."

"Who wants to know your stupid name?"

The growling Gong Pildu showed signs of charging his mini-turret again, so I quickly added.

"If you don't mind, I'd like to have a word with the person behind you."

"What?"

At my words, the boy who had been hiding behind Gong Pildu's back poked his head out.

I waved to the boy who made eye contact.

"Hello?"

The boy quickly hid again.

An unfamiliar face.

In the entirety of Omniscient Reader, there had never been a boy like him by Gong Pildu's side.

[Using 'Readers' Comments List' on this person.]

[Checking the reader's profile information.]

Just by looking at it, I already knew what kind of person he would be.

Hmm, so he's like that.

While I was quickly checking the reader's information, Gong Pildu looked back at the boy and asked.

"Do you know him?"

The boy shook his head.

"Wait. Think again."

That's not good enough.

Fortunately, a wonderful reader of mine once told me how to deal with a situation like this.

"Aren't we 'between friends'?"

"Friends.....?"

"Between friends."

Suddenly, the boy's expression changed.

Before I knew it, the rest of the party was standing next to me.

The boy looked back and forth between me and my group a few times, and his eyes widened when he realized that Jung Heewon was among us.

Slowly, the boy's small lips opened.

"9158.....?"

---

A moment later, I was grabbed by the nape of my neck by Yoo Joonghyuk and dragged toward the railroad tracks.

I was used to this by now.

In the distance, I could see the boy talking to my party.

A few steps away from him, Gong Pildu was staring in our direction with disapproving eyes.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at Gong Pildu and asked without even glancing at me.

"How did you convince him?"

"Because a villain knows best about villains."

"Cheon Inho....."

"I'm The One Who Deceived the Stars, and the Evil Sophist."

Yoo Joonghyuk looked back at me.

"What you need is not the human Cheon Inho, but the 'Ten Evils' that tormented you."

Yoo Joonghyuk suspected that I was not Cheon Inho. The best I could do now was to convince him of my usefulness.

"How can I trust you?"

"Weren't you the one who trusted me and asked me to be on the same side?"

"Did you recover the memories of the previous turn? Looks like you managed to meet Anna Croft."

Fortunately, he seemed to be able to communicate to some extent.

As expected, Kim Dokja was right. There was no such thing as a bad Yoo Joonghyuk in the world.

"But the situation has changed from the previous turn. It was a ridiculous idea to join hands with a Ten Evil after all."

Though there could be a lying Yoo Joonghyuk.

I quickly added before Yoo Joonghyuk could grab a spear and stab me.

"Don't think too much. This isn't the time to be picky with your companions. Are you thinking of hitting the reset button again?"

"You."

Unfortunately, I don't know everything that happened in the 40th turn. What I heard was only part of the conversation between Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho.

But for now, it's enough for me.

"Didn't you say yourself that this was the last time you could reset and that everything in the universe would be destroyed in this turn? Was it all a lie?"

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes shook wildly.

"Honestly, you don't seem very desperate right now."

After a moment of silence, Yoo Joonghyuk stared into the darkness of the tunnel, as if there was a fierce enemy beyond it.

"I need a moment to think."

With that, Yoo Joonghyuk started to tap the railroad tracks with the tip of his spear and began to pace.

I left him alone with his thoughts and approached the others.

The boy from Chungmuro was already exchanging information with the others, especially Kyung Sein, whom he seemed to be extremely close to.

"This is the 41st turn?"

"Yes, that's right."

"Oh my God. So that's why that Yoo Joonghyuk..... No wonder he was such a scumbag....."

I had a general idea of what they were talking about.

Apparently, the boy didn't know how many turns Yoo Joonghyuk had passed through.

The mumbling boy spotted me and jumped up from his seat.

Kyung Sein introduced the boy to me.

"Inho-ssi! This is the 7th Apostle from the Seven Apostles!"

The 7th Apostle.

Like Killer King, this boy was also a member of the Seven Apostles. If he was the 7th Apostle, he had to be the last of the Apostles.

I extended my hand, and the boy nervously shook it.

"Oh, hello."

"Yes, it's nice to meet you."

"So this is what Cheon Inho looks like..... He's much more handsome than what I've read."

I grasped the boy's small hand and smiled bitterly.

It was the first compliment I heard since I possessed Cheon Inho.

"Thank you. Why don't we start by introducing ourselves? I'm Cheon Inho, as you know."

"I'm Ye Hyunwoo."

"That's your name, right?"

"Yes."

Ye Hyunwoo.

Listening to the name, I seemed to remember that there was a character with that name in Chungmuro's setting.

Ye Hyunwoo's sparkling eyes looked closely at my face, and then he asked.

"But how did you know I was an apostle?"

How did I know.

ID: Princemaker77[1]

Platform: Series

Total Comments: 681

Reader Level: 97

Number of Reads: 50.4 times

* You can use coins to view the comments written by this reader.

* Number of comments currently available for free: 3.

[NOTE 1]

I couldn't help but know.

Once I checked the platform, it was clear he wasn't an illegal reader, and more importantly, this boy had over 50 reads.

He wasn't like Killer King with 99.8 complete reads (almost 100 reads), but he was definitely like 0.5 of him.

So I thought.

Anyone who had read the novel this many times was 100% a member of 'that organization'.

"I recently met someone who seemed to have a similar vibe."

"Who?"

"Killer King."

"The 2nd Apostle? You're saying I'm like him?"

Ye Hyunwoo blushed as if he had heard something embarrassing.

Seeing him like this, I found him more likeable than that wannabe Yoo Joonghyuk.

"I actually heard from him. I heard there was a reader possessing a supporting villain. I guess it was Cheon Inho-ssi. Anyway, that bastard's always trying to act cool. Cheon Inho....."

"Killer King has been here?"

Ye Hyunwoo nodded.

"It's been a while. He even asked me to go with him, but I'm not the adventurous type."

Certainly, his choice to have Gong Pildu as his partner made that clear.

Safety first.

A wise choice in an apocalypse like this.

"By the way, thanks for stopping me earlier. If I had known that he was the 41st turn Yoo Joonghyuk, I would have never fought him. Damn Killer King, he didn't even tell me that."

Killer King didn't know that either, Reader-nim.

By the way, this reader wasn't very normal either.

Even if he didn't know it was the 41st turn, I couldn't believe someone who had read Omniscient Reader 50 times would think of fighting Yoo Joonghyuk.

"That part is a bit complicated."

Ye Hyunwoo said in a weak voice.

"I'm at the third stage of the tech tree[2] 「Plan to Raise an Invincible Castellan at Home」. I should have been able to handle Yoo Joonghyuk by now, according to my calculations....."

[NOTE 2]

What..... Plan?

After letting out a deep sigh, Ye Hyunwoo said an unexpected name.

"Fuck, if Jiyoon was with me, I wouldn't have made this mistake."

---

Author's Note

Jiyoon-ah!

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Princemaker77: It's originally in English.

Note [2]: In strategy games, a technology, tech, or research tree is a hierarchical visual representation of the possible sequences of upgrades a player can unlock (most typically representing the research progress of a given faction). (From Wikipedia)

# 592 Episode 8. Representative Kim Dokja (2)

"D-did you just say Jiyoon?"

Dansoo ahjussi asked, and Ye Hyunwoo frowned warily.

"What?"

"Jiyoon! Do you know Jiyoon?"

"She's my friend, why?"

"Where is Jiyoon now?"

Ye Hyunwoo looked in my direction, startled by ahjussi's sudden outburst.

I tried to calm ahjussi down as he breathed heavily.

"His daughter's name is 'No Jiyoon'."

Ye Hyunwoo's eyes widened.

"No Jiyoon? Really?"

After looking back and forth between me and the ahjussi, Ye Hyunwoo muttered in a cautious voice.

"But it could be someone with the same name....."

"Hyunwoo-ssi, is your friend the same Jiyoon who said she's going to marry Yoo Joonghyuk in the future?"

In response to my question, Ye Hyunwoo nodded with a dazed expression.

"Huh? That's right. Wow, you really are Jiyoon's father. No, but if you're here, does that mean Omniscient Reader.....?"

"Where is Jiyoon now?"

This was the first acquaintance of his daughter he had met since crossing over to this world. Dansoo ahjussi was almost out of breath.

"I'm sorry..... I haven't met Jiyoon since I came here either."

"Ah....."

"But Jiyoon must be here somewhere too. I was dragged to the theater by her."

At the mention of the theater, Kyung Sein asked.

"Did you happen to be at 'Kim Dokja's Banquet' as well?"

"Yes. Were you too?"

"I was there too....."

As expected, most of the readers in the theater were transmigrated into this world.

Even Dansoo ahjussi chimed in.

"I was in the hospital when I was suddenly brought in....."

He was possessed even though he was outside the theater. Then maybe it wasn't just the people in the theater who came.

Ye Hyunwoo sighed and added.

"If I had known this would happen, I wouldn't have gone. I was in a really good mood until I got the quiz right. I was looking forward to the gift since I got the difficult quiz right....."

"What did you get right?"

"Well, the meaning of 1,863....."

"Oh, so that was the 7th Apostle."

I also vaguely remembered.

The person who, in a confident voice, correlated Yoo Joonghyuk's regressions with the year the first subway opened.

Maybe the girl sitting next to him was the one who asked if Kim Dokja was resurrected.

Then, was the girl who asked about Kim Dokja Jiyoon?

Ye Hyunwoo sighed as if it were already a habit and glanced in the direction of Yoo Joonghyuk, who was still pacing the railroad tracks.

"I haven't seen Jiyoon since we got separated at that time. Of course, I thought she'd be by Yoo Joonghyuk's side by now..... She doesn't seem to be possessing Jihye."

Dansoo ahjussi's expression darkened sharply at the offhand remark.

"Still, if it's Jiyoon, she's alive somewhere, so don't worry too much. There's no way such a tough girl could be dead, and she's read the Book of Revelation more than I have."

I paused when I heard that.

Jiyoon had read it more than 50 times?

As if to change the subject, Ye Hyunwoo smiled slightly.

"By the way, it's amazing that you've made it this far already. I've read it 50 times. I was lucky enough to start near Chungmuro, but you guys....."

"We started at Geumho Station."

"Wow, at 'Geumho Station'? Well, since you're 'Cheon Inho'..... So you met Jung Heewon there too, right?"

"Yes."

Jung Heewon was talking to Lee Jihye a dozen steps away. Apparently, Lee Jihye took the initiative to ask her questions.

"It's really unusual. Jung Heewon becoming companions with Cheon Inho... Is this development okay?"

When he asked me that, I was speechless.

I thought it was a novelty in terms of development.

"Anyway, I'm relieved to see other members of the Apostles. It was really hard to deal with Killer King when he came with a bunch of kids from the Misreading Association."

The moment I heard those words, I remembered the dead bodies of the outer species at the front of the tunnel. Apparently, it was the work of Ye Hyunwoo and Gong Pildu.

"Did the Misreading Association attack here as well?"

"You've already met them, right?"

"Thanks to Killer King."

"Eh, that asshole..... Anyway, they came here as well. It seems like they prepared a lot for this early rush. Of course, I think they definitely underestimated the third stage of my Invincible Castellan tech tree."

Ye Hyunwoo seemed to have a special attachment to Gong Pildu and talked to us about his Plan to Raise an Invincible Castellan at Home for a while.

I wondered how much he had talked.

"I want to go home."

I felt like I had been pricked by a thorn in the center of my heart.

I didn't know how long it had been, but Ye Hyunwoo had tears in his eyes.

It belatedly dawned on me that Ye Hyunwoo was Jiyoon's age.

On the surface, everyone seemed excited to be in a novel, but there was no way anyone would really want to be in an apocalypse like this.

Kyung Sein clenched her fists, and Dansoo ahjussi, who had stood up from his seat, reached over the boy's shoulder as if to comfort him.

It was then that we heard a voice from behind him.

"Stop talking and come here, kid."

Ye Hyunwoo rushed over and sat down next to Gong Pildu. Ye Hyunwoo whimpered, and Gong Pildu glared at me like he was going to kill me.

He was only in his mid-to-late teens. Such a child had endured the first and second scenarios and survived to this point.

I wanted to tell him anything. That he would make it home safely. That nothing would happen.

But who was I to say that?

Tsuchuchuchut.

Everyone's pockets vibrated with the same sound.

One by one, with a slight time difference, we pulled out our phones.

And then.

"Inho-ssi."

Kyung Sein's nervous voice.

She wasn't the only one. Dansoo ahjussi and even Ye Hyunwoo, who was next to Gong Pildu, had similar faces.

The same message appeared on everyone's phones' screens.

—It's been a while. Dear readers.

RepresentativeKimDokja sent a message.

"This, right now—"

I quickly looked around.

It was to see if we were the only ones looking at our phones.

"Let's check it first."

I opened the message.

—Hello, dear readers. By now, you're either on the second scenario or, if you're fast, already on the third.

—You've all survived well. Of course, some of you haven't, but what can I do? You should've read it harder.

The strange coolness in the way he spoke.

Was this really a message from the 'Representative Kim Dokja' I knew?

—I'm sure you're all wondering. Why me? Did I do something wrong to be transmigrated into this world? Was it because I read that damn novel? But I didn't even say anything bad about it. Who the hell put me in this world and why?

Suddenly, I had an ominous premonition.

"Everyone! If you haven't seen the message yet—"

But I didn't finish my sentence.

—I'm sure you're frustrated. So, for those readers who have made it this far, I thought I'd give a little presentation on why you were brought to this world, and.

Tsuchuchuchut— I saw Kyung Sein, Dansoo ahjussi, and Ye Hyunwoo collapse one after another like dolls with broken threads.

—What you must accomplish to return to your original world.

My vision went black as well.

—See you soon then.

---

A dark tunnel.

The woman in the white coat, who had been watching Chungmuro Station with a lollipop in her mouth, jumped up from her seat.

"Hey, remember all the guys whose phones just rang."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' asks what's wrong with them.]

"They're all possessed. Also."

The woman added, checking the faces of Cheon Inho and his party who fell down one by one.

"Track the coordinates of the newly created subspace. Find out where their souls have been called. Quickly."

---

When I opened my eyes, I was lying in a large lobby. As I got up, I realized that my eye level felt strangely familiar.

Slowly, my eyes adjusted and took in the scene around me.

The unlit ticket office and unmanned ticket machine.

It was Chungmuro's theater.

As I approached the ticket machine, I saw a face on the black screen.

My face was reflected in it. Not Cheon Inho's face, but Lee Hakhyun's face.

I laughed out loud, and a sense of sadness crossed my mind. A deep sense of relief washed over me, along with an unexplainable sense of regret.

Maybe it was all a dream.

There was no such thing as transmigrating into a novel, after all. There was no way something like a web novel could suddenly happen to me.

It was then that the ceiling lit up.

A dazzling pillar of light descended from the surroundings, and people began to be summoned one by one.

"Uaaaah!"

"What!"

Some people screamed, while others looked around with calm faces.

They appeared in an instant.

I realized who they were.

「Readers.」

The readers who had been transmigrated into the novel with me. It wasn't until I saw them that I realized.

We had all been called here, just as we were in the real world.

I quickly counted the people. A number that seemed more than a hundred, even at a rough count.

Apparently, there were more possessed people from other places besides those in the theater.

I had counted about a hundred and twenty of them when I spotted a head that stood out from the crowd.

I didn't recognize anyone else, but I recognized them.

"Sein-ssi."

"Eh? Who?"

The surprised man turned his head toward me, and I saw his name tag.

[JudgeHeewon].

The man seemed to recognize my name tag as well.

"I-Inho-ssi? You must be Inho-ssi!"

"That's right."

"Uaaah! Inho-ssi!"

Kyung Sein swooped down and gave me a big hug.

I quickly pulled away from him and asked.

"Did you see the others?"

"Well, I don't know the others' real faces."

Well, that's true, too.

As if they had realized what was happening, the sounds of people searching echoed around the room.

"Mijin-ah! Seo Mijin!"

"JihyesLove-nim! Is JihyesLove-nim here?"

"NamwoonsMom-nim!"

Come to think of it, there was someone I needed to find too. Maybe this was my only chance.

"Sein-ssi. I have to go somewhere for a while too."

"What? Inho-ssi! Wait!"

I pushed my way through the crowd, checking people's faces one by one.

"Ji Eunyu-ssi! Is Ji Eunyu-ssi here?"

Ji Eunyu, my assignment editor.

The one who brought me to this theater. She must have transmigrated here too, because she read Omniscient Reader and answered the quiz correctly.

"Ji Eunyu-ssi!"

But there was no sign of Ji Eunyu.

Has she not been summoned yet?

Or.....

I bit my lip hard. It wasn't anyone else, it was 'Ji Eunyu'. The one who had probably read my novel more than me.

There's no way Ji Eunyu didn't survive.

It was then that I heard a familiar name.

"Jiyoon-ah..... Jiyoon-ah!"

A neatly dressed middle-aged man was crouched on the ground, calling for someone desperately.

"Ahjussi."

As I approached, the middle-aged man looked up at me. It wasn't a face I remembered, but the moment I saw those eyes, I was sure.

"Inho..... Mate?"

It was the unmistakable Dansoo ahjussi.

"Yes."

The real-life Dansoo ahjussi was just as handsome as the novel version.

The only difference was that this man looked so pale that it wouldn't be strange if he collapsed immediately, and his body was built like a dry tree.

"I'm sorry, mate, Jiyoon. Jiyoon, please....."

Dansoo ahjussi fainted on the spot leaving those words. His head was burning with fever. I hastily carried him on my back. His body was as light as a child's.

I looked around nervously.

Should I take him to the hospital?

But there was no way I could get there.

The theater's exits and elevators were blocked by translucent walls.

This wasn't the 'theater' we knew, but a subspace someone temporarily created.

There was no way to escape.

There was only one thing I could do now.

"Jiyoon-ah! No Jiyoon!"

I started shouting at the top of my lungs to the surrounding area. Kyung Sein, who hurriedly caught up, realized what was going on and shouted Jiyoon's name together with me.

"Jiyoon-ah, where are you!"

Time and time again, I saw children who looked to be Jiyoon's age, but I couldn't find Jiyoon.

Soon, all the pillars of light disappeared.

The summoning was finally over.

The next moment, I stopped dead in my tracks, feeling a strange sense of heavy pressure. It was hard to breathe, and my head felt dizzy.

「Something is looking at us.」

I lifted my head with difficulty, as if defying gravity.

Since when had they been there?

Someone was floating near the ceiling of the theater.

Wearing a white coat that resembled Kim Dokja's and his trademark sunglasses, he was talking to us.

【Welcome to 'Kim Dokja's Banquet'. Everyone.】

RepresentativeKimDokja.

The one who summoned us to this world.

---

Author's Note

The usual process of writing the author's note.

Sing: How about ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ (brainstorming too much)?

Shong: No.

Sing: Then thank you for today.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 593 Episode 8. Representative Kim Dokja (3)

---

At the sound of RepresentativeKimDokja's words, the chatter of readers calling each other's names and nicknames quickly died down.

As a heavy silence settled over the room, I could see the readers' appearances clearly.

They ranged in age from teenagers to people in their 60s.

Some looked like friends and siblings, others wore aprons as if they were cooking. Some were dressed in neat suits, while others were in their pajamas, shyly hiding by a pillar.

Apparently, this was a place where everyone would show themselves as they were 'just before they were transmigrated'.

No matter what kind of person the readers were, their demeanor was the same here.

A deep silence, not even the sound of breathing could be heard.

Eventually, RepresentativeKimDokja spoke again.

【I'm sure you all have a lot of questions, but you are not saying anything.】

All who had survived so far were veterans.

Old-timers who had survived the hell of the first and second scenarios.

【Certainly, the first person to step forward at times like this is bound to get their head cracked off. You all know the clichés very well.】

As if he understood, RepresentativeKimDokja's lips curled into a smile.

【But you can rest assured this time. I'm not here to harm you. The Banquet is short, so ask any questions you want.】

The readers looked at each other.

Even if RepresentativeKimDokja said that, it wasn't easy to believe him.

After all, he had the power to summon all the readers here.

He could probably kill everyone here with a snap of his fingers.

「That is, of course, if this guy can handle the 'probability'.」

In the beginning of the original scenarios, it was impossible for a high-grade constellation to descend in their true form or summon such a large number of incarnations.

That's why I was able to raise my hand.

Tsuchuchuchut.

A spark had been flowing faintly through his body since earlier.

There was no way a man who was already overdoing it would put on a show of killing an incarnation like a dokkaebi.

But there was a reader who raised his hand faster than I did.

RepresentativeKimDokja pointed to him and said.

【Oh, go ahead.】

He looked to be in his mid-to-late teens, and he was quite a memorable reader, with his unique serious eyes.

"Who are you, and where am I?"

【Curiosity about people and places. Good, that's how stories start. Who is the main character and where is this place?】

Inhaling lightly, RepresentativeKimDokja looked back at the other readers and said.

【But who I am and where this place is doesn't matter, because I'm not the main character in this story. I'm just—】

"Are you Kim Dokja?"

Several readers gasped at the boy's question.

That's probably the biggest question on most people's minds here.

Is this 'RepresentativeKimDokja' the 'Kim Dokja' we know?

RepresentativeKimDokja raised his eyebrows slightly.

【You can think what you want about me. I may or may not be Kim Dokja. But more importantly —】

"Come to think of it, I don't think you're Kim Dokja."

The boy's voice was subtly hostile.

RepresentativeKimDokja paused.

【What made you think that?】

"There is no way Kim Dokja would bring us to a dangerous place."

The boy's voice was calm and rational.

Next to him stood a girl who seemed to be related to him, but her eyes were unusually closed.

It didn't seem to be because she had narrow eyes like Cheon Inho, but because of other circumstances.

After staring at the two, RepresentativeKimDokja smiled.

【Are you two siblings?】

"That's none of your business—"

【That's sweet. The Kim Dokja you know would never summon your blind sister to this world. Did you come up with such a naive idea?】

As the boy clenched his fists and frowned, the girl tightened her grip on his sleeve as if to restrain him.

RepresentativeKimDokja laughed in satisfaction.

【Kim Dokja is not a character who sympathizes with anyone for just that reason; if he were, he wouldn't have let the old woman die in the first scenario.】

I thought the line was somehow familiar, and then I remembered that I had written a similar scene in Omniscient Reader.

【He led people to stab each other to death at Geumho Station.】

Maybe it was during the 'Duet Between Good and Evil'.

【In 'The Strongest Sacrifice' scenario, he sat on the sidelines and allowed tens of thousands of Seoul citizens to die.】

Everything RepresentativeKimDokja said was true.

However, the readers didn't seem to be shaken by his words.

【Do you really believe that such a Kim Dokja wouldn't bring you in for his own purposes?】

"He wouldn't."

【Why?】

"Because—"

"Because I am a fragment of that 'Kim Dokja'."

It was a girl across from him who cut the boy off.

A girl about Jiyoon's age.

"I know because I'm a fragment of Kim Dokja. Kim Dokja wouldn't do this."

The conviction in her voice was so strong that even I was stunned.

The girl really believed in Kim Dokja.

Maybe she wasn't the only one.

"Are you really 'RepresentativeKimDokja'?"

Even an ahjussi who had been watching the conversation.

"I've messaged RepresentativeKimDokja before, but you don't sound like him."

The others, who had been timidly backing away, also chimed in.

"What are you trying to say? We know what kind of person Kim Dokja is better than you do."

"Why are you dressed as Kim Dokja in the first place? Just reveal your identity."

As he listened in silence, RepresentativeKimDokja took a deep breath. When he drew in his breath, it felt like all the oxygen around us suddenly disappeared.

When I turned around, I saw that not only I, but also the others had turned pale.

【That bastard Kim Dokja.】

As I felt my breath return, RepresentativeKimDokja spoke.

【Kim Dokja, Kim Dokja, Kim Dokja, you're really loud. Why the hell do you like him so much?】

He sounded like he had a grudge against Kim Dokja.

【All he cares about is the life and death of <Kim Dokja's Company>. He's a heartless god who doesn't care how many extras die in his dreams.】

I felt like someone was poking me in the head with a needle.

Part of me knew that. In a way, I knew it was possible to think like that.

【In your favorite story, was Kim Dokja really a good person?】

A giant screen floated up behind RepresentativeKimDokja. The screen showed a scene from the scenario. Judging from the atmosphere, it wasn't the world line we were on a moment ago.

「"I wish to see the novel's epilogue."」

It was a story in a novel that I once wrote and the readers once read.

From the first scenario to the last. The long journey of the protagonist, Kim Dokja, and <Kim Dokja's Company>.

Kim Dokja's story, from Kim Dokja's point of view, for Kim Dokja.

RepresentativeKimDokja said.

【You've all thought about it at least once: In that world, what kind of life will those who are not chosen by Kim Dokja live?】

Beneath the feet of <Kim Dokja's Company>, who marched toward the end of the world, nameless corpses piled up.

Their souls cried out.

They were in that world.

They were part of this story too.

But Kim Dokja didn't look back at them.

【I believe you know the truth about what it's like to be an extra in this world.】

The readers were speechless for a moment. Even those who had been defending Kim Dokja were unable to say anything for once.

On the screen, a close-up of an incarnation dying alone in a scenario change. A lonely incarnation dying without the gaze of any stars.

He looked at me and said.

「"Save me....."」

Maybe someone between us is possessing that incarnation now. Death was no longer just an extra's story.

It was our story.

"What are you trying to say?"

It was I who spoke.

"Are you asking us to relieve some dead extra's resentment? That's why you dragged us into this damn world?"

RepresentativeKimDokja grinned from ear to ear, and then a message popped up in front of me. As if that was his answer.

[The <Star Stream> has agreed to register a new sub-scenario for you.]

[A new sub-scenario has arrived!]

**<Sub Scenario(???) — Record Qualification>**

Category: Sub (Personal)

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: You have been transmigrated into the world line through an 'Outer World Covenant'. Work with the other transmigrated people to prevent its predestined destruction and develop a new story.

Time Limit: —

Reward: Return to the original world line and additional rewards.

Failure: Death

To a certain extent, this was expected.

We are from another world, just like Kim Dokja when he went to the 1,863rd turn.

It was only natural that there would be a scenario to return to the original world line.

The problem was the content.

「Prevent its predestined destruction and develop a new story.」

Prevent the predestined destruction.

In other words, RepresentativeKimDokja summoned us because he wanted to change the ending of this world line.

I could hear the boy who had first spoken to him earlier muttering.

"As expected, an 'Outer World Covenant'....."

I looked around and saw that some of the readers had already calmed down and started calculating.

The hope that if they could somehow prevent the destruction of this world, they could return to the original world.

As they gathered their thoughts, a few raised their hands and asked.

"Wait, you have to tell us where this world is. Is this Yoo Joonghyuk's '3rd turn'?"

"Is <Kim Dokja's Company> also here somewhere?"

"Where is Kim Dokja now? Is he with us?"

At that moment, everyone had a similar thought in their minds.

The surest way to prevent the end of the world.

Borrowing the power of those who had already 'stopped the destruction'.

But.

【Why do you want to know that?】

RepresentativeKimDokja didn't seem to like the question.

【Are you really planning to rely on <Kim Dokja's Company> here as well? Really, you still haven't come to your senses.】

The readers who had been asking questions shivered at the cold voice.

RepresentativeKimDokja sighed softly and shook his head.

【Keep this in mind. You are the protagonists of this world, and this world exists only for you.】

He swept his gaze across the room with a strange glint in his eye, then added with a slight smile.

【Please, make a story worthy of being written on the 'Last Wall'. That way, this world will not be forgotten in vain.】

For some reason, his last words sounded sincere.

【This is the end of this Banquet. See you next time.】

RepresentativeKimDokja's figure disappeared into thin air, and pillars of light began to appear everywhere. One by one, the summoned people were returning.

The surprised readers called out each other's names.

After regaining our senses, Kyung Sein and I looked at each other.

We hadn't found Dansoo ahjussi's daughter yet.

We hurriedly called out Jiyoon's name and searched through the rest of the crowd. Then, I bumped shoulders with someone. I turned around and saw the boy who had confronted RepresentativeKimDokja earlier.

The boy frowned and said.

"Hm? By any chance, you—"

The boy, along with the girl next to him, was engulfed in a pillar of light and disappeared.

In a matter of moments, the crowd had shrunk to less than half.

Now there were no readers who looked Jiyoon's age.

"Inho-ssi—"

A pillar of light rushed right next to me and then Kyung Sein's figure disappeared.

Almost simultaneously, the weight of Dansoo ahjussi on my back disappeared.

A deep sense of emptiness washed over me.

I didn't find anyone after all.

It was then that a familiar backside caught my eye.

A small back, light brown bobbed hair that fell to her shoulders.

For a moment, my heart beat wildly.

「The person who had made me a writer was there.」

The one who never gave up on me, even when everyone else in the editorial department did.

My editor.

"Ji Eunyu-ssi!"

She was alive.

I knew she would be alive.

The moment Ji Eunyu turned around, a pillar of light descended from thin air.

Ji Eunyu's surprised eyes looked at me.

I felt my breath catch in my throat.

There was no time. We couldn't even afford to ask each other who the other was possessing. All we could do was shout,

"Gwanghwamun!"

We could only agree on a meeting place.

Ji Eunyu was the last one, there was no one left in the theater.

I was left alone.

Soon, I would be gone too.

I sighed lightly and waited for my turn.

One minute, two minutes.....

I kept waiting.

Three minutes, four minutes.....

Something was wrong.

No matter how much time passed, my body was not enveloped in a pillar of light.

What was going on?

I absentmindedly looked up at the ceiling, where the lights were flickering intermittently.

"Excuse me?"

I asked, but no one answered.

"Hey!"

I called out a little louder, but still no answer.

I hesitated for a moment, then made a decision.

I decided to explore the area a bit more.

After all, there was something that had been bothering me since earlier.

.....

As I listened, I heard a faint sound. I hadn't heard it wrong.

There was someone else in this theater besides me.

The sound was coming from the entrance to the theater tucked away in one corner of the lobby.

In front of the theater's door was a sign that said 'playing'.

I wondered what was playing.

A movie?

As I cautiously opened the theater door, a feeling of anticipation flashed through my mind.

「"Inho-ssi? Inho-ssi, wake up!"」

The familiar voice triggered a series of memories. Slowly, a chill ran down my spine.

I knew this place.

「"Why is Inho-ssi the only one who didn't wake up?"」

The view of Chungmuro Station reflected on the vast screen, and there were my companions waking me up from my collapse.

And then.

The backs of countless 'kkoma Kim Dokjas' watching the scene.

It was the same movie theater I had seen in my dream.

The kkoma Kim Dokjas I met that day were not part of a dream.

The moment I took a stumbling step into the theater, a kkoma Kim Dokja looked back.

The name tag pinned to his left chest shook.

rlaehrwk37.

As soon as the kkoma Kim Dokja's eyes widened and he was about to say something to me, something grabbed me by the back of the head and yanked me hard.

It was a cold grip that sent a chill down my spine.

【You shouldn't have seen that.】

The voice was icy cold.

When I turned my head, RepresentativeKimDokja was looking at me.

Author's Note

Thank you.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 594 Episode 8. Representative Kim Dokja (4)

【Hm? You.】

RepresentativeKimDokja grabbed the back of my head and looked into my face for a long time.

There was a strange tension in the air.

Thinking about it, this wasn't my first encounter with 'RepresentativeKimDokja'. I had met him once before at the Chungmuro Theater.

Back then, he had seen my face and even checked my name tag.

Was that all?

He gave me privileges to help me adjust to this world, and he read the entire Omniscient Reader I had written and left comments and impressions.

I wondered.

Would 'RepresentativeKimDokja' recognize me?

【Hmm.】

Or rather, he didn't recognize me, just as I expected.

【That's weird. How come you haven't gone back yet?】

RepresentativeKimDokja walked out of the theater, holding the back of my head like a cat clinging to a fish from a fish tank.

Yoo Joonghyuk had done the same. I didn't know why the hell everyone who saw me wanted to carry me around.

Anyway, he didn't recognize me after all.

I hesitated for a moment, then decided to implement the plan I'd been thinking about.

'Thoughts.'

As I said the name in my head, the bracelet on my wrist twitched.

I don't know exactly why, but unlike my other items, 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' had been summoned here with me.

Either way, it was a good thing for me right now.

"Wait, I don't like hanging like this."

I grabbed RepresentativeKimDokja's wrist, who gripped the back of my head while thinking. I could feel the surface of the bracelet resonating against his hand.

['Thought' is making contact with an unknown item.]

Look at this.

I'm clearly touching his skin, but you call it an 'item'?

[Beginning target analysis.]

[Target analysis will take 5 minutes to complete.]

[Maintain contact until the end of the analysis.]

RepresentativeKimDokja was deep in thought and didn't notice 'Thought'.

I spoke up again in a frustrated tone.

"I didn't go in there because I wanted to, I was just trying to find a way out of here."

【What did you see in there?】

"Little kids....."

[Someone has used 'Lie Detection'.]

'RepresentativeKimDokja' must be an 'outer god', and if you're an outer god, you're bound to have [Lie Detection].

That's a good thing for me.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 4' has been activated!]

"I saw some little kids watching a movie inside the theater. But it was dark, so I couldn't see much."

[You have incited yourself.]

I immediately opened my mouth.

"What movie were the little kids watching?"

【What kind of movie was it?】

"I couldn't look closely because it was dark."

[Someone has confirmed that the statement is true.]

【Hmm.....】

RepresentativeKimDokja glared at me with suspicion, then slowly loosened his grip on the back of my head.

But I did not let go of his wrist.

[Continuing the analysis of the target.]

"Wait, what are those kids, and why are there so many of them here?"

【Do you want to know?】

I couldn't see RepresentativeKimDokja's eyes because he was wearing sunglasses. However, I could clearly feel the life that radiated from them.

"Well, I'm not too curious."

【Good, because a story where you know the ending is boring.】

RepresentativeKimDokja nodded in satisfaction.

【Now, if you'll let go of my wrist, I need to find out why you didn't make it back.】

That's a problem.

I'm not done analyzing you yet.

"I still have one more question."

【Is that a question you can only ask while grabbing my wrist?】

Behind his sunglasses, I could see the murderous intent once again.

But this time, I didn't back down.

"Who are you?"

【Hmm? Like I said, I—】

"You're not the 'RepresentativeKimDokja' I know, because I've met him before I came here."

In reality, I had only met him once, but I had known him for a very long time.

He messaged me every day for the duration of the series.

I found 'RepresentativeKimDokja' to be a very serious and story-loving person.

But what about the 'RepresentativeKimDokja' in front of me now?

【That's some great insight. Even though our appearances should be exactly the same.....】

Unexpectedly, RepresentativeKimDokja readily admitted the truth.

【You're right. The 'RepresentativeKimDokja' who brought you here is a different being. Is that enough to answer your question?】

There were two RepresentativeKimDokjas.

Maybe more than two.

Is it a group?

If so, what does this group exist for?

[The analysis is more than 80% complete.]

【It's my turn to ask. You—】

"Why 'Kim Dokja'?"

【What?】

"If you needed to disguise yourself, you could have been Yoo Joonghyuk or someone else."

【No, this is just—】

"I thought you hated Kim Dokja?"

At my question, for the first time, RepresentativeKimDokja's complexion changed.

【Why do you think that?】

"Was it actually because you were envious of him? Is that why you took on Kim Dokja's appearance and you're imitating him?"

RepresentativeKimDokja's face slowly hardened. It was as if a vague clue had been unraveled.

[The exclusive attribute is activated!]

For a brief moment, the clues left by RepresentativeKimDokja at the previous Banquet branched out in my mind.

「Kim Dokja, Kim Dokja, Kim Dokja, you're really loud. Why the hell do you like him so much?」

He harbored a grudge against Kim Dokja.

「What kind of life will those who are not chosen by Kim Dokja live?」

He sympathized with those who were not saved by Kim Dokja.

「Are you really planning to rely on <Kim Dokja's Company> here as well?」

He wanted to complete the end of the world without <Kim Dokja's Company>.

So my reasoning went like this.

"Did Kim Dokja..... ruin your story?"

He is a 'character' who could not fulfill the story he wanted because of Kim Dokja.

That's why the readers of 'Omniscient Reader' have been kidnapped into this world.

「To create the story he wants.」

Who could he be?

I had a few characters in my head, but no names I was sure of.

【You..... Who are you?】

A sudden momentum began to emanate from RepresentativeKimDokja's entire body.

For a moment, I felt sick.

I was digging too deep.

Tsuchuchuchuchuchut—

Intense sparks began to fly around me.

In my head, I weighed the magnitude of the sparks against my life.

How much probability would it take for him to kill me?

And how much more probability was he willing to sacrifice?

[The item analysis has been completed!]

[The item is 'Ever-changing (千變萬化)[1] Stealth Suit.]

[NOTE 1]

[The item is S-grade.]

[You must be hit at least 10 times by the user of the item to obtain the item's form.]

Just in time, the analysis of 'Thought' had ended.

「Ever-changing Stealth Suit.」

An item of clothing that consumes a certain amount of magic to turn the user's appearance into the desired one.

In other words, he was using the item's power to hide his true self.

'Thoughts.'

I immediately changed the form of the bracelet.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 4' has been activated!]

「Turn into the Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick.」

I wielded the 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick' with all my might at RepresentativeKimDokja in front of me.

The corner of his lip twitching, RepresentativeKimDokja lightly stretched out his arm and grabbed the bamboo stick.

Of course, I didn't expect the attack to work. But it wasn't the strike I was aiming for in the first place.

Soon, a bright light emanated from the end of the bamboo stick.

[The hidden property of 'Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick' has been activated!]

As a damaged star relic, it was unable to produce its original power, but it had no problem triggering the hidden property.

[The stigma 'Skeleton in the Closet' has been triggered!]

If he's wearing the 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit', he'll have no choice but to reveal his true self in front of this stigma.

Patsuchuchut.

['Skeleton in the Closet' is affected by your status.]

[Your status does not allow you to determine the target's identity.]

Damn it, that was too much for my level.

But for the briefest of moments, I saw part of his cheek crack.

Beyond the crack, an unspoken tension pulsed. A flow of stories so dangerous as to be mind-numbing. An ominous sensation lurking beyond.

Demonic energy?

The moment I thought that, his fist slammed into my stomach.

【You must think I can't kill you.】

The feeling of my stomach being ripped open and pierced.

Even though I was a soul, my breath caught in my throat.

【In fact, you're right. I can't kill you directly. There are restrictions on that.】

My left and right arms snapped in different directions, and a painful sensation washed over me, as if my legs had been amputated.

As soon as I inhaled, something slammed into my stomach again.

For a moment, my consciousness slipped away and came back.

【But I can give you a pain worse than death.】

He held both my arms together and pushed me back against the wall, then put his magically formed thorns into my wrists and ankles one after another.

Pow. Pow. Pow. Pow. Pow.

In an instant, five or six thorns pierced my limbs.

I activated my skill just before the pain began to spread.

[The level of the exclusive skill 'Incite' has increased!]

「I am Kim Dokja who has the [Fourth Wall].」

【Certainly..... You're not like other readers. I can't believe you can endure this pain.】

He lightly lifted my chin with his long fingers, and then said with interest.

【Come to think of it, I did hear about a special guy from another Representative.....】

"If I'm a special guest, you should treat me specially."

I provoked him.

I had to provoke him further, push him over the edge.

"If you're only this good, you would have already lost to Kim Dokja."

The spark that had been running through his body earlier was getting stronger and stronger. Any moment now, he wouldn't be able to withstand the aftermath of probability.

【I'm getting more and more curious about who you are.】

But RepresentativeKimDokja was smiling subtly at me.

It looked like he was as pleased as angry.

【Suddenly, I feel very nostalgic.】

RepresentativeKimDokja's head turned slowly to an odd angle.

【Right now, you look like someone I hate more than anyone and wanted to eat at the same time.】

Pow.

I felt something dig into my stomach, and the next moment, my stomach was clutched in his grip.

A pain that even the level 5 [Incite] couldn't handle.

Tsuchuchuchuchut.

It was then that something began to ooze from the hole in my stomach.

Sentences, shimmering with golden light.

Stories.

RepresentativeKimDokja's eyes widened.

【This is..... No way? You.....】

The moment he reached out for the story that had fallen to the floor.

「■■■ ■■■ ■■」

The story began its storytelling.

The space around me ripped apart, and my ears rang like a storm was brewing here.

Then I heard a clear voice.

「I told you not to touch it.」

RepresentativeKimDokja's expression hardened. His eyes widened and he looked me in the eyes.

Something was speaking through my mouth.

「They are coming.」

With those words, the ceiling of the movie theater crumbled.

Within my blurry consciousness, I saw RepresentativeKimDokja look up.

Someone shouted, and something flew through the cracked ceiling.

A beautiful thread of light.

It caught me by surprise.

In my slowly fading consciousness, I heard the voice of the angry RepresentativeKimDokja.

It was probably,

「.....Kim Dokja's Company!」

He seemed to say something like that.

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Author's Note

Did we hear it wrong?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: 千變萬化: Literally 'thousand changes, ten thousand changes'.

# 595 Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (1)

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It was around the time I was writing the episode 'Disaster of Floods'.

When Kim Dokja was beaten and his intestines were torn out by the 41st turn Shin Yoosung, Ji Eunyu said something like this.

「"Author-nim, don't you think it's a bit unlikely that he's still in his right mind with a hole in his stomach?"」

I don't know what I said then.

I think I said something like this.

In fantasy, you can have your limbs cut off and a hole in your stomach, but your mouth is still alive.

And then I said.

「"Kim Dokja has the [Fourth Wall]."」

Even if you don't have the [Fourth Wall], the most important thing is mental strength.

At that time, I thought I could overcome anything with mental strength. I believed that if I couldn't overcome something, it was because I didn't have enough mental strength.

If I could go back to that time, I would slap myself on the back of the head.

I'm sorry. Kim Dokja-ssi.

I was wrong.

It hurts a lot.

I begged and begged and begged, in pain that felt like my body was going to break in half. I wondered how many times I had to beg until someone would answer.

「..... ..... .....」

It was a very faint voice. I couldn't hear what was being said, but I could clearly see that they were very compassionate and warm words.

The pain eased a little.

In my blurry vision, I could see a thread wrapped around my stomach. I brought my hand to the warm threads.

Beyond the fluttering thread, brown hair fluttered like flower petals.

「..... .....」

I wanted to ask.

Who are you, where am I?

Why did you save me?

「..... .....」

My consciousness continued to drift, the words slipping away.

I felt someone hold my hand, and something inside me stirred and rose. Like it was [Incite], it was like a weight had been lifted off me.

I wanted to say.

I can't do this alone.

I can't change the world, I can't protect people.

I wanted to say, please help me, protect the people.

Then the person on the other side of the thread spoke.

「I can't.」

---

"Inho-ssi! Inho-ssi!"

When I opened my eyes, Kyung Sein and Jung Heewon were in front of me.

"He's awake! Inho-ssi woke up too!"

Chungmuro.

It seemed that I had safely returned to the place where my body was.

I casually looked down at my stomach, which was safe and sound.

"What the hell is going on? Everyone suddenly collapsed, and Inho-ssi wouldn't wake up....."

Jung Heewon sighed heavily as she held my shoulder tightly.

No one had told Jung Heewon what we had been through, judging by the way Kyung Sein was avoiding my eyes. Perhaps it was a wise decision.

"Inho-ssi. Are you okay? Did you hit your head somewhere?"

"No. I'm fine, thank you."

Jung Heewon put her hand on my forehead and stood up.

"Stay here for a while, I'll get you something to drink."

While Jung Heewon was gone, Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi quickly sat down next to me.

"Inho-ssi, you've been there all this time, right?"

"Yes..... But wait a minute."

I closed my eyes for a moment and organized what had happened in my head.

There were four main pieces of information I learned from the 'theater'.

One, in the theater, the 'kkoma Kim Dokjas' are watching us.

Two, 'RepresentativeKimDokja' has a grudge against Kim Dokja.

Three, 'RepresentativeKimDokja' is a 'character'.

Four, someone saved me from 'RepresentativeKimDokja'.

Each piece of information was shocking and hard to put into context.

All I know is that 'RepresentativeKimDokja' is up to something, and he's using us to plan something.

And.....

「..... Company!」

After hearing that last part, I lost consciousness, and I don't remember exactly what happened after that.

I could barely remember that someone escorted me out of that space.

A few deductions flashed through my mind, then quickly disappeared.

「No way.」

When I opened my eyes, Kyung Sein chimed in as if she'd been waiting.

"Inho-ssi, he brought us here, right? RepresentativeKimDokja."

"Yes. It looks like it."

"I didn't see him like that, but I'm really disappointed. How many times did I read the 'Encyclopedia of Omniscient Reader' that he wrote—"

I was about to say that this RepresentativeKimDokja and that RepresentativeKimDokja must be different people, but I shut my mouth.

It didn't matter at this point.

"But he said that if we somehow prevented the destruction, he would let us go home....."

Will 'RepresentativeKimDokja' keep his promise?

I don't know.

If I had to guess, I'd say that since he was an 'outer god' and we had an 'outer world covenant', his promise was valid.

That is, if we somehow managed to prevent the scenario's destruction.

"I thought Inho-ssi was in trouble because you woke up late. Did anything happen?"

I kept the story short, leaving out the details. There were a lot of people around, and I didn't think it was the right time.

"I didn't know if it was a bug or what, but I was the only one there for a while, even after everyone else had disappeared."

"Inho mate, maybe."

At my words, Dansoo ahjussi squeezed my hand. I held his hand back lightly and shook my head.

"I'm sorry, I didn't find Jiyoon."

"Oh."

Dansoo ahjussi's expression quickly darkened.

"It's not time to give up just yet. There were a lot of kids around Jiyoon's age that I didn't get to talk to."

"Really?"

To tell the truth, there weren't that many people who were Jiyoon's age, but it wouldn't do any good to tell him that now.

Kyung Sein also helped.

"That's right, ahjussi. Plus, this world is Omniscient Reader's. Even if the worst comes to the worst, there's always a way out."

"You're right, Sein-ssi."

This world is Omniscient Reader's.

If someone dies here, it doesn't mean they're dead forever.

There are constellations in this world that rule the afterlife, and all dead souls go there.

But I wonder if my readers and I can go to the underworld.

Maybe, like the 41st turn Shin Yoosung, we will be lost in the world without going anywhere.

As I thought about it, I suddenly felt fear.

「Where did all the readers who have already died go?」

As I stared blankly at the stairwell leading upstairs, I saw the 7th Apostle Ye Hyunwoo descending with some people.

"Inho-ssi, are you up?"

I bowed slightly as he rushed over to greet me.

After glancing around, Ye Hyunwoo whispered in a low voice.

"Inho-ssi, you were 'there' too, right?"

"Yes."

"It's a pity. If I knew your face, I would have greeted you."

Perhaps Ye Hyunwoo was also in the theater. Which one of them he was, I don't know. Some readers would know.

"There will be another chance next time. What's going on?"

There was a bustle of people coming down from upstairs. Voices shouting with urgency. I could see them busily moving materials around.

"Oh, that."

Judging by the hardened expression on Ye Hyunwoo's face, something must have happened while I was asleep.

"Inho-ssi!"

Jung Heewon ran over with water from a distance, and her expression was grave.

I got up from my seat, wondering what was going on.

[All the 'green zones' in this region have been destroyed and the main scenario has collapsed.]

An unexpected message came through.

[The difficulty is automatically adjusted according to the remaining schedule of the scenario.]

This can't be happening.

This is starting now?

[The scenario content is updated!]

**<Main Scenario #3 — Emergency Defense Battle>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: B-

Clear Conditions: All the 'green zones' in the region have been destroyed and the monsters that were going to be created in the remaining days have suddenly run wild. Survive against the flood of monsters for the remaining time.

Time Limit: 8 hours

Reward: 2,000 coins

Failure: —

I recalled the description of 'Emergency Defense Battle' in Omniscient Reader.

「Once the 'Green Zone' scenario is bypassed, the monsters supposed to be created during the remaining time would emerge all at once.」

The timing was faster than when Kim Dokja fought the 'Emergency Defense Battle'.

In other words, we would have to deal with a much larger number of monsters than he did in Omniscient Reader.

A pensive Kyung Sein looked at me and muttered.

"I-Inho-ssi. What should we do?"

In the former Omniscient Reader, Kim Dokja and his group destroyed all the 'green zones', and an 'emergency defense battle' was held.

But now, there was no Kim Dokja in Chungmuro.

So why did the scenario start?

[The 'green zones' were destroyed too quickly.]

[The difficulty of 'Emergency Defense Battle' will be adjusted.]

[People will be banned from entering the station from now on.]

['Emergency Defense Battle' will begin in five minutes!]

Fortunately, we were given time to prepare.

I quickly looked back at my companions and said.

"It's okay. Everybody calm down."

Even if the scenario was more difficult than the original, in the end, the point of 'Emergency Defense Battle' was to fend off from a group of 9th grade underground species 'ground rats' and 8th grade underground species 'grolls'.

In that case, the situation was not bad.

Thanks to Ye Hyunwoo's performance, we had Gong Pildu's assistance, and most importantly, we had.....

"We have the strongest card, don't we?"

Ye Hyunwoo asked with a smile.

"Do you happen to have a hidden hand?"

"I'm talking about Yoo Joonghyuk."

The 41st turn Yoo Joonghyuk.

If the monster who could beat a poisonous rhinoceros from the beginning teamed up with Gong Pildu, 'Emergency Defense Battle' would be no problem.

Of course, whether or not Yoo Joonghyuk would help us was a separate story, but judging by the atmosphere so far.....

"Kids, get up! Now is not the time to play around! Dammit. This is why I was....."

Gong Pildu's shout rang out.

The people who had gotten the artillery from somewhere began to quickly build up a fort in the middle of the platform.

But..... Where did Yoo Joonghyuk go?

"Inho-ssi."

Ye Hyunwoo's expression was dark as he turned around.

"I didn't tell you earlier. Why I was fighting with Yoo Joonghyuk."

I didn't get to hear Ye Hyunwoo's story because we were suddenly summoned by RepresentativeKimDokja.

"I didn't fight him because I wanted to. As a reader who finished the story, there's no way I would choose to fight that monster."

"Then....."

"That bastard tried to destroy all of Chungmuro's 'green zones'."

I got a little goosebumps.

By the 41st turn, Yoo Joonghyuk should have known that 'Emergency Defense Battle' would start when all of Chungmuro's 'green zones' were destroyed.

"Where is Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"He went upstairs. When we were asleep, he smashed all the remaining green zones."

Ye Hyunwoo said through gritted teeth.

At that moment, someone tapped me on the shoulder.

"Uh, ahjussi. You woke up?"

It was Lee Jihye.

"Master said to tell you. Hmmmm."

Clearing her throat, Lee Jihye put her hands on her hips and mimicked Yoo Joonghyuk.

"If you're really Cheon Inho, you can do this alone."

I didn't need to ask what she meant by that.

['Emergency Defense Battle' has begun!]

Lee Jihye added with a smile.

"Then I'll be watching over there."

With those words, Lee Jihye jumped up to the top of the stairwell.

Honestly, I wanted her to help, but I didn't have time to convince her right now.

Gong Pildu called out in a loud voice.

"Here we go. Gather round, everyone!"

It was a relief to have him on our side.

Standing next to me, Ye Hyunwoo said in a low voice.

"Don't worry too much. I've been working hard since the first day to prepare for something like this. Although we're a little ahead of schedule....."

Ye Hyunwoo climbed onto the fort and stood tall like an experienced captain, instructing everyone.

"Take your positions! We'll go as we practiced this morning!"

Apparently, they had already practiced the formation, so they didn't panic and prepared to take cover behind the fort.

I was impressed again.

It was a different atmosphere from the one Geumho Station had when I left.

People moving in an orderly fashion, like a well-trained army.

I wondered what kept them so united.

"Who protects our land?"

"We protect it!"

I remembered in hindsight.

That's right. Chungmuro was like that.

A fortress of the 'Landlord Alliance', controlled by the landowner Gong Pildu.

It was Ye Hyunwoo who commanded the fortress now.

"According to my calculations, this is around the fourth stage of the Invincible Castellan tech tree, and with the synergy of the Invincible Siege Formation, we should be able to handle Emergency Defense Battle. We're still at the third stage of the tech tree, but at this rate, we'll be there soon—"

I don't understand why this guy is still only the 7th Apostle..

Killer King should immediately give up his 2nd place to Ye Hyunwoo.

"We'll help too."

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi exchanged glances as they each grabbed their weapons.

"Inho-ssi."

And Jung Heewon, standing in front of me.

"Don't step up and recover, and stay well hidden behind me."

Kyung Sein stepped forward with her shield, and Dansoo ahjussi gathered the bugs with his bamboo stick.

And as I watched Ye Hyunwoo adjusting his formation next to Gong Pildu, I suddenly remembered RepresentativeKimDokja's words.

「"All he cares about is the life and death of <Kim Dokja's Company>."」

His words weren't entirely wrong. In the end, the only thing Kim Dokja was able to save was <Kim Dokja's Company>, and in fact, he couldn't even do that properly.

But his story was recorded and told. And there were readers who read the story.

People who remembered better than anyone else how they fought and what kind of life they lived.

「And so, the story is not over yet.」

In the distance, the cries of ground rats could be heard, followed by an ominous vibration coming from the tunnel side of the station.

Ye Hyunwoo shouted.

"Everyone, defend your land thoroughly! Gong Pildu ahjussi and I will take care of the rest!"

In the darkness, I could see the ground rats swarming like a flock of cockroaches.

After completing the inspection of [Private Property] and [Armed Zone], Ye Hyunwoo sent out the signal.

"Fire!"

Emergency Defense Battle began.

---

From downstairs came the sound of the firing of mini-turrets.

The woman bit the candy in her mouth with a crunch.

She dusted herself off and stood up.

"It's started. We should get going."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' asks if you're really not going to help.]

"Why help them? Our purpose is not to help them, have you forgotten already?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' nods hesitantly.]

"We don't have time to help them in the first place, you saw where that sunfish bastard went."

The woman in the white coat glared up at the stairs to the upper level.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says that sneaky bastard is a problem.]

The woman pulled out a new lemon-flavored candy and said, biting it.

"He's growing faster than I thought. If he gets stronger here, he could be hard to control."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is in deep thought.]

"Our only chance is now. If he goes 'there', he'll surely show an opening."

The woman looked back down the stairwell one last time.

Cheon Inho and the people from Chungmuro were fighting a bloody battle.

The woman stared at the scene for a moment, as if trying to hold it in her eyes, before turning away and saying.

"This ends the 41st turn."

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Author's Note

Thank you. Thank you.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 596 Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (2)

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[Gong Pildu's stigma 'Armed Zone Lv. 5' has begun!]

A full level 5 Armed Zone.

With Gong Pildu's cool artillery barrage, all the ground rats in front of him were silenced.

Dududududu!

The ground rats stepped on the corpses of their comrades and continued to push forward.

"We're being pushed! Watch out!"

Less than ten minutes later, the front row of the fort collapsed. As the ground rats squeezed in through the gap, several panicked people screamed and broke ranks.

"No! Keep your place! Don't run!"

One man was bitten on the arm and dragged forward like a fish on a hook.

"Uaaaagh!"

He reached out belatedly, but was dragged into the swarm of ground rats. The screams didn't last long.

Kyung Sein's shoulders shook slightly as he[1] stood in the front row.

[NOTE 1]

"Inho-ssi."

She said, watching as someone else filled the dead man's place.

"Yes."

"To be honest, it didn't feel real until now."

There was blood spattered and screams everywhere.

People were still dying as we spoke. People who hadn't even been properly named.

"I couldn't believe it even when I saw people die after coming into the novel. In fact, I kept thinking maybe I was dreaming, and by the time I woke up, I would open my eyes again in my bed. That's what I thought."

Another person died, and another filled the void.

"But now I realize."

Kyung Sein said, shaking off a charging ground rat.

"I really don't want to die."

I thought I knew why he had suddenly changed his mind. Perhaps it was because things had changed.

"I want to survive..... I want to survive and I want to go back home."

It was because he had such hope that he could return to the original world.

「Prevent its predestined destruction and develop a new story.」

"I'm going to break all the scenarios somehow and go home."

He stabbed a ground rat to death with a thorn after it crossed the line of fire.

Killing, killing, killing again.

I don't know how many he's already killed in that short time.

Catching his breath, Kyung Sein said.

"As soon as I get back, I'm going to turn on my computer. I'm going to write on the bulletin board. I'm going to brag about it. In fact, I was transmigrated into Omniscient Reader."

"......That's what you're going to do as soon as you get back?"

"That's where I saw Jung Heewon, I saw Cheon Inho, I met Yoo Joonghyuk. No one will believe me, but one day I'll definitely tell them."

While he was still trying to figure out what to say, the man in front of him died. He didn't hesitate to fill the void.

"And I'll definitely read Omniscient Reader's extras too. The author-nim said he was going to publish a series."

I smiled bitterly.

I might be the first one to turn on the computer when I get back.

"We're being pushed again! Molotov cocktails ready!"

As the second line of the fort was gradually pushed back, Ye Hyunwoo gave the first signal.

Several men in the rear fished out empty soju bottles from their pockets.

"Throw them!"

At Ye Hyunwoo's command, Molotov cocktails flew through the air. Gasoline sprayed from the broken soju bottles and set the center of the platform ablaze.

As the panicked ground rats scrambled around, Gong Pildu's shells rained down on them.

He had prepared Molotov cocktails in such a short time. Indeed, the 7th Apostle wasn't a joke.

"Don't be pushed back! It will take a long time to rebuild the [Armed Zone]!"

The core of this siege was Gong Pildu's [Armed Zone].

If the line collapsed further, [Armed Zone] would have to be dismantled, but the current forces were not enough to fill the firepower gap.

As the ground rats slowed their advance, albeit slightly, the man guarding the front fort looked back and shouted.

"More Molotov cocktails! We'll push the line and burn them all to a crisp!"

Something burst through the man's stomach.

It was the horn of an 8th grade underground species, a groll.

"Keok, Keoheook! Kuaaaak!"

"P-pull it out! Quickly!"

"Elder Pildu! Help!"

"Everyone out of the way!"

Dudududududu!

The groll, with the man skewered on its horn, was shot and flew backward.

From the 8th grade species onwards, they were hardly knocked down by Gong Pildu's bullets.

A monster that needed at least four or five shots to fall.

There wasn't just one such monster. They were popping up all over the platform, racing toward the fort like heavy tanks.

To make matters worse, Gong Pildu's artillery stopped firing.

"Shit, I have to reload! Everyone, hold on for time!"

The line was about to collapse.

"Sein-ssi."

It was finally our turn to move forward.

"Yes!"

As Kyung Sein, who had the OP skill [Average Correction] and went all in on physique, held his fire with a cheer, Dansoo ahjussi sent a flurry of cockroaches over the groll's eyes.

Kuooo?

Jung Heewon's sword sliced through its back.

The groll's head snapped off.

As three or four grolls fell in quick succession, the reloaded bullets of Gong Pildu swept across the platform.

Dududududu!

The monsters in front of them were swept away by the firepower of the [mini turrets]. The people cheered.

"Those guys are pretty good, huh?"

"Everyone, protect Pildu hyung-nim!"

"We can do it. Hold on!"

The crisis had been averted for now, but the situation was far from optimistic.

Only thirty minutes had passed. Gong Pildu's face was already exhausted. He was running out of magic power.

In Omniscient Reader, Kim Dokja gave him a large amount of Intermediate Magic Power Recovery Potion to replenish his magic power, but now.....

[The constellation 'Defense Master' is making a worried face.]

As a little more time passed, the number of ground rats getting back to their feet after being hit by shells began to increase.

I wondered if I should open the 'dokkaebi bag' now.

"Kid."

Gong Pildu wiped the sweat from his forehead and called out to Ye Hyunwoo. Without a word, Ye Hyunwoo walked up behind Gong Pildu and stood with his hands clasped together, his small body enveloped in a brilliant blue light.

I immediately recognized the skill.

Instead of restricting one's movement, it speeds up the magic power recovery.

Immediately, I could feel the magic power boiling up from Ye Hyunwoo.

Uuuung.

At first glance, that was a lot of magic power, well over level 30.

That was a lot of magic power for just the third scenario.

It was clear that he had put aside all his strength, agility, and physique, going all in on magic power. It was a choice no one in their right mind would make.

"Here we go. Ahjussi."

The moment Ye Hyunwoo's small hand touched Gong Pildu's back, a faint string of magic formed between him and Gong Pildu.

It was the same way that Yoo Joonghyuk transferred his magic power to Kim Dokja when he fought the 'Disaster of Questions' Myung Ilsang in the original.

Soon, an abundance of magic power began to flow throughout Gong Pildu's Private Property.

The speed of the [mini turrets], which had been slowed down, returned.

Dudududududu!

Ye Hyunwoo was now using himself as a 'magic power tank'.

"This is the fourth stage of the 'Invincible Castellan at Home' tech tree."

After locking eyes with me, Ye Hyunwoo wiped the sweat from his brow and said in a confident voice.

"This is the 'Infinite Uroboros'."

A combination of high-level magic power, [Magic Power Recharge], [Magic Power Sharing], and [Armed Zone].

I was amazed at the precision of the mechanics, but I was also stunned that a human being could actually do this.

I'm sure Kim Dokja would have been just as surprised if he were here.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is amazed.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is aghast!]

[The constellation 'Dragon Lying Down' nods in agreement.]

Lee Jihye, who was watching us from the back stairwell, whistled.

"Wow, that's awesome? I wish I had one like that."

As the firing rate of the [mini turrets] increased, the battle gained momentum.

Jung Heewon and Kyung Sein were enough to fight the occasional grolls, leaving the remaining hands free to rebuild the collapsed fort.

The men working on the new molotov cocktails muttered.

"This is better than I thought?"

"Yeah, if it goes like this, it'll be a smooth ride—"

No, wait.

['Emergency Defense Battle' has entered a new phase.]

The message echoed in the air as if it had been waiting.

I wondered if the word 'smooth' should be banned from Omniscient Reader.

[A new monster species has appeared in 'Emergency Defense Battle'!]

A message that never appeared in the original. In the first place, the Emergency Defense Battle was not a scenario that had different phases.

[A 7th grade monster species has appeared!]

A huge shadow flickered from the railroad tracks. The sound of a subway car scraping across the ground. I could feel the ground shaking under my feet.

"What, what, what is that!"

It wasn't the subway that had emerged from the tunnel. It was a large monster, at least 15 meters long.

'Giant Centipede'.

At the sight of the hundreds of legs beneath its five-colored carapace, the men lost their fighting spirit and rushed toward Gong Pildu.

"Uaaaak! Crazy!"

"H-how am I supposed to catch that thing—"

It can be caught. Yoo Joonghyuk would be able to.

The only problem was, he wasn't here.

I glanced over and saw that Ye Hyunwoo's expression was also stony. It was natural to panic.

"Inho-ssi."

It seemed he was out of tricks.

I stepped forward.

"We'll take it from here."

"Do you have a plan?"

"We'll have to fight it head on and kill it, I guess."

"Like that? How?"

"I don't know..... By stabbing it?"

"I..... Inho-ssi. I don't know how many times you've read it, but that's not just a 7th grade monster species, it's a 'king'. It's a monster that even the 4th stage of my Invincible Castellan tech tree can't handle. I'm telling you as someone who read it 50 times—"

I glanced to the side instead of answering. Jung Heewon, who had just decapitated a monster, was approaching.

"Heewon-ssi."

Wiping the blood from her ground rat knife, Jung Heewon nodded.

"Hide well, I can't protect you this time."

She tapped me on the shoulder and walked away.

Ye Hyunwoo, who was looking at her blankly, smiled bitterly.

"Jung Heewon, I know, she's the best in Kimcom in terms of combat power, but even she can't do it now—"

"Well, I also have a tech tree that I've prepared."

"What?"

Actually, I didn't have anything.

But things didn't always go well just because you had something prepared.

It was the same when I was writing novels.

Sometimes the episodes I had written with thoughts I had in the spur of the moment were way more interesting than the ones I had planned a hundred days in advance.

"Let's see."

Jung Heewon was such a 'thought' for me.

[All of the constellations in the channel agree to the use of 'Hour of Judgment'.]

A 'thought' that came to me when I had given up on everything.

[The character Jung Heewon has used 'Hour of Judgment'!]

Scattering dazzling brilliance, Jung Heewon rushed towards the centipede.

Looking at Jung Heewon like that, I thought to myself.

If this whole scenario were to end and I could return to reality.

「Maybe I would be writing about this moment.」

That's when my phone rang.

[A new chapter of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' has been updated on the platform.]

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Author's Note

The usual process of writing the author's note 2

Sing: What about ㅇㅇㅇㅇㅇㅇ(something cool)?

Shong: Ugh

Sing: Thank you.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Well, Singshong used "he" again so I'll use he/him pronouns when Hakhyun is talking about Kyung Sein in his mind or when they are with people that know about Kyung Sein of their original world.

# 597 Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (3)

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The timing was perfect.

[Enter the platform now to check the new chapter of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.]

Anyway, I think this is the first time I've gotten an update message.

I was tempted to open my phone, but I couldn't afford to right now.

There was a bloody battle between humans and monsters going on a dozen meters away.

"No. What is that—"

Ye Hyunwoo's eyes widened at the sight of Jung Heewon's battle.

"Come to think of it, wasn't Cheon Inho originally killed by Jung Heewon? That's when she became the 'Judge of Destruction'."

"That's right."

"Then how did Jung Heewon awaken now?"

"It's a long story, so let's just watch for now."

Covered in crimson blood, Jung Heewon had already cut off more than a third of the centipede's legs.

'Demon Slaying Judge.'

The Judge's attribute of causing an explosive increase in combat power against monsters resonated with Jung Heewon's Kendo.

Sugagagagak.

With each swing of Jung Heewon's sword, half-dozen centipede legs were sliced off at once.

A precise and swift swordplay, dodging out of the centipede's line of sight, cutting only its feet.

Kyung Sein waved his shield and shouted.

"Uaaah! Heewon's the best!"

Lee Jihye, who had been lying idle in the stairwell, was also watching the battle with fascination.

"Wow, she's killing it....."

The majesty of single-handedly defeating a 7th grade monster species, a King at that.

It was a battle that only Yoo Joonghyuk was capable of, and now Jung Heewon was showing it in front of our eyes.

She was so focused on the battle that her inner voice echoed vividly in my ears.

「I will never lose.」

What was in front of her now was a monster.

But in a sense, it wasn't the monster she was fighting.

「Next time, surely.」

She was alone, fighting an imaginary enemy, a man who was better with a sword than anyone she knew.

Imagining his sword, she swung, and swung, and swung again.

「I have to be faster.」

Jung Heewon knew.

Yoo Joonghyuk's sword was the essence (精髓) of martial arts, forged by the time and effort of countless masters.

She couldn't follow its trajectory now.

However, she could see where it was headed.

A sword forged to shatter the heavens of this world and make the stars fall.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship (破天劍道).

[The character 'Jung Heewon's skill proficiency is rising rapidly!]

Her sword was blossoming from the bitter defeat. A bluish aura was now permeating her ground rat knife.

Dedicated Sword Force (罡氣功).

It was unmistakable. Though it was still faint, it was the Dedicated Sword Force used by the masters of Murim.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' is surprised by the talent of the incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' has entered the channel.]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' is looking at the incarnation 'Jung Heewon' with interest.]

A technique that she learned on her own, without being taught by anyone, without even learning a superlative skill.

Come to think of it, Jung Heewon was also extraordinarily talented in the original.

Could she reach the level of Yoo Joonghyuk in this turn?

[Your 'Free Comments Daily Pass' will expire soon!]

Earlier, they promoted the new chapter, and now they're threatening me to take it away.

[You currently have a total of 6 'Free Comments Daily Pass'.]

[Free Comments Daily Passes accumulate up to a maximum of 2, and will expire if not used within today.]

My head spun. I looked at my watch and it was almost midnight. The pass cost a whopping 3,000 coins.

Just in time, Ye Hyunwoo signaled.

"Everyone in the front, except for Jung Heewon, please step back for a moment! Let's work on the line with concentrated fire from now on!"

With Jung Heewon and the giant centipede fighting it out, all the ground rats and grolls' formations in the area collapsed.

Ye Hyunwoo didn't miss the opportunity and ordered the fire.

Dudududududu!

There was a brief pause in the back-and-forth battle.

It would be fine to check the comments for a while.

I joined the crowd and slipped into the rear, then quickly opened my phone and turned on the platform app.

Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (3)+[24]

Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (2)+[21].

Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (1)+[32].

.....

That was a lot of chapters in a short time. At first glance, there were over 40 chapters.

What did I do to get this far already? I hadn't even finished 'Emergency Defense Battle' yet.

I still hadn't figured out who had written this.

"The people on the back, please check your equipment! We'll be back in action in five minutes!"

I was running out of time, so I decided to check out the recent comments.

Maybe they'd have some useful information.

[1 free daily pass will be deducted.]

[One random comment from the episode will be released, regardless of order.]

| |
|---|
| —Oh |

.....

Even if it's from a free pass, I get pissed off every time this happens.

Luckily, I still had five free passes left.

[1 free daily pass will be deducted.]

| |
|---|
| —Uh |

I think it should be illegal in Korea to leave a one-syllable comment.

[1 free daily pass will be deducted.]

| |
|---|
| —Yoo |

Yoo?

I redeemed a pass once again.

| |
|---|

—Joong

If the next comment I see is 'Hyuk', I might actually want to die.

I was about to nervously redeem my fifth free pass.

[A new feature has been updated!]

A notification popped up.

[You can spend an additional 1,000 coins to see the comments that have received the most 'upvotes'.]

1,000 coins.

That's a bit expensive, but.....

At least if a comment is highly recommended, it's more likely to contain nutritious information, right?

[1 free daily pass will be deducted.]

[You have spent an additional 1,000 coins.]

[Checking the comment that received the most 'upvotes'.]

A comment immediately popped up.

—Yoo Joonghyuk is stuck on the sunfish route again

Upvotes 236 / Downvotes 5

Sunfish is the nickname of Yoo Joonghyuk, who often dies and regresses.

My head was spinning.

Did it mean that Yoo Joonghyuk was going to die?

But it couldn't be.

The Yoo Joonghyuk I saw in the 41st turn was more like a scumbag than a sunfish.

In the distance, I could see Jung Heewon, who had cut off all the legs of the giant centipede, delivering the final blow.

"Get ready to go in one minute!"

The five minutes were already coming to an end.

I hesitated for a moment and used up the last pass.

[You've used up all the free daily passes.]

[You have spent an additional 1,000 coins.]

[Checking the comment that received the most 'upvotes'.]

> —Yoo Joonghyuk is not the problem, Cheon Inho is about to catch up
>
> Upvotes 189 / Downvotes 3

I looked around with anxiety for a moment.

Gong Pildu was firing shells steadily, and the line of ground rats had been completely pushed outward.

After finishing off the giant centipede, I could see Jung Heewon running towards me, stomping on a ground rat's head.

There was nothing weird.

Time hadn't stopped, and the world hadn't turned colorless, so—!

———!

The floor of the platform exploded in front of me, sending me flying through the air as debris rained down and scattered.

With my ears ringing, I spit out dust and stood up. My vision hadn't recovered yet, so I couldn't tell what happened.

A man who had been catching the ground rats a few moments earlier was being torn apart by them, his body separated from the waist down.

Horrified people crawled on their asses.

The fort collapsed with a single explosion.

The ground rats had broken through the turret line and were tearing the incarnations apart.

"Help me! Help me!"

Gong Pildu's shattered turrets could be seen in the dust, his proud [Private Property] and [Armed Zone] both destroyed.

Ye Hyunwoo was shaking the bleeding Gong Pildu.

"Ahjussi! Ahjussi!"

What the hell had happened?

Surely everything was going well. There wasn't even a warning from '■■'.

What the hell?

Kkukukukuku.

A monster species emerged from the settled dust.

['Emergency Defense Battle' has entered a new phase.]

[An additional 7th grade monster species has appeared!]

Giant Centipede.

It was even bigger than the one Jung Heewon had caught. Jung Heewon stretched out her hand and called out.

"Inho-ssi!"

There was another explosion from the ground.

[An additional 7th grade monster species has appeared!]

The tail of the beast protruding from the ground collided directly with Jung Heewon.

I barely caught the body of Jung Heewon that was sent flying.

"Heewon-ssi."

Jung Heewon let out a painful breath. It seemed that she had received a heavy blow to her back when [Hour of Judgement] was released.

A middle-aged man crawling on the ground next to me shouted.

"E-everyone, run!"

The middle-aged man stepped on my phone, which had fallen to the ground. Above the cracked screen, the platform screen I was looking at floated.

| Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (3)+[34] |
| --- |

The comments grew in real time.

All I could see was the comments of my readers.

I don't know how the chapters are actually written.

「"You've all thought about it at least once: In that world, what kind of life will those who are not chosen by Kim Dokja live?"」

In the five thousand characters of text, I wondered if our story was being written properly.

How many people died in this 'Emergency Defense Battle' that Kim Dokja couldn't see until the end. How many suffered.

What stories were told.

Will the reader of this chapter know that now?

「"I believe you know the truth about what it's like to be an 'extra' in this world."」

Probably not.

Because their deaths are not stories people want to read.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' yawns and says he's getting a little bored.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' wants a novel scenario solution.]

Because a generic extra's death doesn't attract any of the stars' attention.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is watching your choice.]

As I stood up with Jung Heewon in my arms, a ground rat pounced through the dust.

"What are you doing? Are you out of your mind?"

With a slash, it was sliced in half.

Lee Jihye was in front of me.

"Master told me to keep you alive."

She spat out the gum she'd been chewing, and didn't even look back at me as if she was bothered.

The giant centipede that had spotted us was coming this way.

"I can't catch that kind of thing either. I'll just buy time, so pull yourself together and go upstairs now."

Lee Jihye is strong. This kind of adversity won't kill her.

The writer of this story knows it, and the reader knows it.

Perhaps Lee Jihye herself knows this.

「But what about Cheon Inho?」

I slowed my pace and stood beside Lee Jihye.

Lee Jihye's eyes widened as she killed the approaching ground rats.

"What?"

"Please take care of Heewon-ssi."

Lee Jihye, who received Jung Heewon without hesitation, looked at me in surprise.

I ignored her and started walking forward.

I stuck a thorn into the head of an approaching ground rat and kept walking.

"What the hell! Ahjussi! Do you really want to die?"

Die?

"I won't die."

If this really was a life-threatening situation, time would have stopped and the world would have turned colorless.

And I would have a manuscript opening with all sorts of negative scene titles, like 'The Death of the Villain', 'The Villain's Crisis', 'The Villain's End', and so on.

So this silence was a clear opening line for me.

「Cheon Inho won't die here.」

"Ah, stop! You're really going to die!"

The platform was littered with the bodies of dead ground rats and humans.

I blinked slowly, as if taking a photograph.

[Describe your own behavior.]

[You have spent 5 probability points.]

The reason I activated my skill now was not to survive.

[The exclusive skill '■■' has been activated.]

It was only because I had something I wanted to write.

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Author's Note

There are many things I want to write, but they won't let me

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 598 Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (4)

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[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

In the colorless world, all blood looked the same.

No red blood, no blue blood. Everything was gray.

I felt sad.

In this wide world.

[The exclusive skill '■■' resonates with your emotions.]

There's not a single piece of paper for extras.

# Words That Can't Be Said

「■■■

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield' for a total of 3 minutes.]

I began to write. It wasn't a story I was writing for anyone.

There are stories like that. Stories that are neither artistic nor interesting, but you can't resist writing them.

[You have described something that cannot be evaluated.]

[You cannot assess the reproduction success rate of this story.]

[You can't measure the probability you've been granted.]

[Checking the reader's feedback.]

[There is no reader's feedback.]

There was no feedback.

However.

[rlaehrwk37 recognizes your story.]

Someone has definitely read this story.

[rlaehrwk61 recognizes your story.]

[rlaehrwk99 recognizes your story.]

[rlaehrwk73 recognizes your story.]

.....

[You've earned probability from a certain number of referrals.]

[Successfully recreating the scene.]

[Leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

I blinked slowly, and the colors of the world returned.

In front of my eyes, a ground rat bit a breathless person.

「Lee Hakhyun knew. Why the extras were never talked about.」

I know better than anyone.

It's the writer, not anyone else, who excludes the extras from the story.

「Because their stories are already written.」

An unnamed ground rat bit an unnamed man to death.

As I stabbed the nameless ground rats again, I thought to myself.

「These pages, which no one can read, are their story.」

What had been a gray, snowy world was now covered in red and blue blood.

Stories that are not told because they are everywhere.

Death in the middle of unwritten lines.

「There are no sentences for extras.」

It was a matter of course.

The moment you write a sentence for an extra, they become a protagonist.

When one person becomes the protagonist, the rest become extras.

"Help—"

"KKuaaak!"

I barely saved one person, and another died.

I never learned the names of the dead. Even though I was right next to them, I couldn't see how they died.

Dead people with their eyes open as if in mourning.

Damn it, even in this scene, I was a writer. An insensitive recorder, trying to write a sentence on the blank space created by their deaths.

「Nevertheless, someone has to make footprints in this snowfield.」

A ground rat nibbled at my thigh.

「Someone has to be the protagonist, after all.」

I swatted it away, and a second one bit my arm.

「That's what this snowfield is for.」

I slammed my arm down on its head. But when I killed one, two came, and when I shook them off, three came.

"N-no—"

"Inho-ssi! Stop! Inho-ssi!"

Looking back at the stairwell, I saw the faces of Kyung Sein, Dansoo ahjussi, and Ye Hyunwoo one after another.

Gong Pildu and Jung Heewon hadn't regained consciousness yet.

Lee Jihye was busy fending off the monsters coming up the stairwell.

"Ahjussi, what are you doing! Hurry up and come this way!"

There were still quite a few people who hadn't made it to the stairwell. The fort formations had all collapsed, and the people were cornered.

At this rate, Chungmuro Station would be wiped out.

I made a decision.

I don't know if this will work.

"Thought."

Still, I had to try.

"Let's go."

'Thoughts of Almost Everything' gurgled into the bracelet.

I commanded it.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 5' has been activated.]

「Turn into the Ever-changing Stealth Suit.」

Ever-changing Stealth Suit.

The disguise item that 'RepresentativeKimDokja' was wearing.

At the time, I had fulfilled the requirement of 'being hit 10 times' to obtain the appearance of the 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit', which allowed me to place this item on the mimicry list.

[Putting on the 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit'!]

「Transform into a ground rat.」

A moment later, with a blinding flash of light, my appearance changed to that of a ground rat.

The ground rats that had been pouncing on me stopped in their tracks.

They sniffed and hovered around me.

Some of them bared their fangs at me, showing their intense hostility.

I suppose it's natural for them to be suspicious, since they saw me as a human just a moment ago.

I used [Incite] on them.

「I am a ground rat.」

A few ground rats came up to me and sniffed, then one by one they scurried past me.

Luckily, the plan worked.

I ran backwards through the procession of ground rats and quickly made my way to the center of the platform.

I could see two giant centipedes roaring at the ceiling.

Before long,

Everywhere I looked, the ground rats let out wild cries.

And then.

「..... .....」

I heard a strange voice.

I turned around, wondering where it was coming from.

[Your exclusive attribute has been activated.]

[You understand the language settings.]

[You are interpreting the language of the ground rats.]

「Go up」

The ground rat was speaking.

「Runrunrunrun」

「Stayclosetomommy」

「Justalittlebitjustalittlebit」

「Upupup」

A ground rat that was passing by me stopped to look at me.

「Notthatway」

It looked at me and added.

「Runthisway」

I asked it.

"Why?"

「BecausethatstheorderBecausethatstheorder」

The order. By who?

The ground rat shuddered, looked back toward the tunnel, and started running past me again.

I couldn't hear the answer, but I knew why it was running.

Humans are not the only participants in scenarios.

Everything in this world belongs to the 'scenario'. This was true even for the ground rats in front of me.

「Mommy」

「Helphelphelp」

「Cantbreathecantbreathe」

I looked down at the floor. There was a pile of bullet-riddled ground rats corpses.

Dozens of times more than the dead humans.

「The extras, they don't even realize they're extras.」

A huge shadow was cast over me.

「You」

Since when? A giant centipede was bending over my head.

「Why did you come this way?」

I looked around without answering.

This was the center of the station.

People were almost at the top of the stairs. The important thing is to stall the time from now on until Gong Pildu unleashes the [Armed Zone] again.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 5' has been activated!]

「Look this way!」

In response to my [Incite], a bunch of ground rats turned to look at me.

「Whatwhatwhatwhat」

「Wherewherewherewhere」

It wasn't enough.

I shouted again.

「This way!」

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 5' is being used to the limit!]

[The level of the exclusive skill 'Incite' has increased!]

Poosyuk, Blood trickled from my nose with the sound.

This time, more of them looked back at me. Some of the ground rats that ran straight ahead, others that jumped up to the stairwell and attacked people.

They were all looking in my direction.

「Whatwhat」

「Whowhowho」

「Whywhywhywhywhy」

I suddenly remembered the 'outer gods' from Omniscient Reader. They were extras who died as 'Nameless Ones' in the worldview of the 'Ways of Survival'.

I was not a Kim Dokja, so I did not have the power to save them.

Instead, I was forced to kill them all to end the scenario.

'Thoughts.'

I invoked it, and in my mind's eye, I could see the forms I had collected so far.

Magic Power Recovery Bracelet.

Damaged Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick.

Ever-changing Stealth Suit.

Magic Power Stove.

And.....

I didn't want to use these items until the end. Because, in return, the platform would be a dead zone for a while.

But now I had no other choice.

「Turn into a 'Poison Bomb'.」

Poison Bomb. It was an item they left behind when we fought the Misreading Association.

A biochemical weapon made from the anal sac of a poisonous rhinoceros.

I picked up one of the used bombs at the time and put it on the possible mimicry list.

[The consumed item is restored by the effect of 'Thoughts of Almost Everything'.]

[The rare occasion of shape evolution has occurred!]

[The form of the item has evolved to a higher level!]

['Thoughts of Almost Everything' has turned into 'High-Level Poison Bomb'.]

A moment later, a faintly glowing bomb appeared in front of me.

[This item is a consumable item.]

[When the item is used, you won't be able to use the form again.]

[The effect of the 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit' will be lifted.]

As I reverted to my normal form, the ground rats growled and showed their hostility.

But none of them pounced on me. Even the giant centipede kept a wary distance and glared at my hand for a reason.

They know.

If I detonate this bomb now, every monster in the station will be wiped out.

「Ohnomommyimscared」

「Hidebehindmom」

I stared at them for a moment.

「Whatsgoingon」

「Humanhumanhuman」

「IdontwanttodieIdontwanttodie」

I slowly opened my mouth.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 5' has been activated.]

「You don't have to die like this.」

I looked back at the ground rats, the giant centipedes, and the grolls.

「Don't hurt any more people and go back. Then I won't kill you either.」

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' admires your boldness.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' opens its mouth at your suggestion.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' marvels at your integrity.]

I know the odds are slim.

But theoretically, the monsters and humans could resolve the scenario without harming each other.

[There are 7 hours and 12 minutes remaining until the end of the Emergency Defense Battle.]

I continued.

"Emergency Defense Battle is a scenario with a time limit. It will end at some point, even if they don't hurt each other."

I could feel the ground rats' agitation.

「A story where no one is the protagonist, maybe.」

The extras had died enough. Monsters and humans alike knew.

[The ground rats are confused by your 'Incite'.]

Monsters, too, are but incarnations. They also fear death.

They have families, they have friends.

They have lives.

Tsuchuchuchuchut!

It was then that sparks exploded in thin air.

[Some dokkaebis find your attempts to be a threat to the scenario.]

[Many constellations are eager to see the scenario unfold quickly!]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is moving.]

[Your 'Incite' has been lifted.]

[Emergency Defensive Battle will resume.]

[A few constellations laugh at your reckless behavior.]

Looking at the message, I thought.

「After all, isn't this world one giant instigator?」

One of the ground rats looked at me and said.

「Thereisnosuchstory」

With those words, a swarm of ground rats pounced on me.

I replied.

"Yes."

There was a loud explosion. A blizzard of poisonous gas, accompanied by an unpleasant odor, swept across the platform.

I heard the screams of the monsters. The giant centipedes and ground rats dying, their bodies spewing black blood.

I could see the monsters from the tunnel falling to the ground as well. As I watched them die, I thought to myself.

「If only the monsters hadn't died here, this story would have been interesting.」

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' cheers for the mass murder.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says that monsters are best when they're dead.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' admires your idea.]

[The constellation 'Dragon Lying Down' appreciates your strategy.]

.....

I stumbled, barely able to catch my breath. I felt like I was going to collapse at any moment, but it wasn't time yet.

I swallowed the Poisonous Rhinoceros' Horn Powder little by little and turned around to start walking.

One step, two steps.

I walked and walked and walked through a landscape swallowed up by the dense fog, stabbing each approaching ground rat thoroughly, one by one.

I swallowed the nausea that rose. A few times I stumbled over dead bodies, and then got back up.

I heard a small cry in my ear. It was a dying ground rat. I was about to strike it down with my thorn.

Kking.

I realized that the ground rat was already dead. Instead, I found a tiny creature squirming in its arms.

It was a ground rat pup.

I stared down at it in disbelief.

「After all, every story has a protagonist.」

As if it wanted to live, the pup struggled to breathe and exhale with difficulty.

I could see the tip of its nose turning black from exposure to the gas.

I bent down and scooped it up in my arms. I poured a little of the remaining Poisonous Rhinoceros' Horn Powder into its mouth.

Its groans gradually ceased.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is watching your story.]

I walked across the platform with the pup in my arms. It was hard to see through the fog.

[The constellation 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight' is watching your story.]

I walked and walked and walked, relying on the faint voices of the stars.

Little by little, my consciousness faded.

I could hear voices in the distance.

They were the voices of those looking for me.

The tip of my foot caught on something hard. It was the stairs. I had to go up.

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is watching your story.]

I glanced back absentmindedly.

The bodies of so many monsters and humans, now buried in the thick fog, were nowhere to be seen.

I took a step up the stairs, and a single footprint imprinted itself.

[You have achieved an impossible feat.]

It was a pitch black footprint.

[Your first 'story' is germinating.]

I went up the stairs.

---

Author's Note

Thank you.

---

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 599 Episode 9. Words That Can't Be Said (5)

---

Everything is white. An empty, blank space, like a manuscript page with nothing written on it.

My thoughts blinked like a cursor.

「"Inho-ssi, how did you become a writer?"」

Jung Heewon asked me that question when we were trapped inside the ichthyosaur.

Strangely, the answer didn't come to me immediately.

How did I become a writer?

The memory was distant and fuzzy.

「You're here?」

I forced my eyes open and saw a snowy sky.

I immediately realized where I was.

A snowfield covered in white.

As I slowly raised myself up, I saw the face of the protagonist I knew so well.

「Kim Dokja.」

Kim Dokja nodded. Just like the last time we met, he was still standing alone in the snowfield.

He waved lightly at me, then squatted down and stared at the ground. He was looking so intently at the ground that I couldn't help but approach and ask.

「Is there something there?」

Kim Dokja shook his head and smirked. His finger pointed down.

There was a pitch black footprint.

It wasn't the original footprint.

They were clearly recent.

I looked down at my feet, then back up at the print.

Then I slowly squatted down next to Kim Dokja.

「I wanted to be strong like you.」

I don't know why I said that, it just came out of my mouth.

「Like you.....」

「You know.」

Kim Dokja said.

「I'm not that strong.」

As he said this, he slowly turned around and saw the vague trail of footsteps behind him.

Kim Dokja, as if counting the footprints, said.

「I just kept walking.」

Keep walking.

Kim Dokja continued.

「It's going to be very hard from now on.」

「.....」

「It will be lonely.」

After hearing those words, I felt really lonely. I said.

「This story won't have a happy ending.」

Kim Dokja didn't answer for a moment.

We looked at the footprints. Footprints that had disappeared. Footprints that were being made. And footprints that would be made.

Kim Dokja asked.

「Will you be alright?」

I nodded slowly.

「As long as you keep reading.」

Kim Dokja's eyes were on me. I felt awkward and averted his gaze.

He said.

「Well, it's not supposed to be like that.」

He hesitated, rummaged through his coat pockets, and placed something in my hand.

「Take it. And.....」

---

I opened my eyes with a sigh.

It was Chungmuro Station.

"Inho-ssi!"

I put a hand on my forehead and raised my upper body. Kyung Sein's face came into view.

"Everyone....."

"It's okay, everyone's okay."

Kyung Sein squeezed my hand.

"Hey, Inho-ssi."

It was then that Dansoo ahjussi came to my side. He sat on his knees and stared at me.

His face looked like he was scolding me, or maybe he was worried.

But he didn't ask me anything, just hugged me quietly.

Then Kyung Sein next to us suddenly burst into tears and hugged us both.

In their arms, I looked out at the scenery of Chungmuro Station.

I could see the faces of the survivors.

Gong Pildu, Ye Hyunwoo and other people were building a fort at the foot of the stairs.

I could also see a large tarp over the entrance to the stairwell to prevent the poisonous gas from rising.

On the bench, injured people were tending to their wounds.

Some incarnations fell asleep after eating the [Elaine Forest Essence].

I could also see Jung Heewon lying on the ground and Lee Jihye sitting on the bench, staring at the tarp.

[There are 3 hours and 39 minutes remaining until the end of the 'Emergency Defense Battle'.]

[The 'Bureau' is currently considering an early end to the 'Emergency Defense Battle'.]

A faint cheer erupted from the people building the fort.

Early termination of the scenario.

It was an option the Bureau was considering.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' grumbles about how long he has to watch the obvious.]

[Some constellations are asking if the results are out already.]

The constellations were getting tired of the scenario, and it was clear that more time here wasn't going to change the outcome.

Even now, behind that tarp, monsters were dying in real time from the poisonous fog.

I stared at the thin membrane that separated the life and death of humans and monsters.

"Ah, Inho-ssi."

Ye Hyunwoo spotted me and waved at me. I hesitantly waved back.

"You."

A large shadow fell over my head. I looked up and saw a head glistening in the fluorescent light.

Gong Pildu frowned and ran his eyes down my arms and legs, each one scarred with the bite marks of ground rats.

"What were you going to do if you died?"

"I thought I wouldn't die."

Gong Pildu stared at my face for a long time, as if he didn't like my answer.

"Thanks to you, we all lived."

I swallowed hard.

It wasn't anyone else, it was Gong Pildu. The Ten Evils of Chungmuro Station. The second most proud person in the entire Omniscient Reader.

He had just expressed his gratitude to me.

However, Gong Pildu's expression was a little strange.

"What is that?"

Suddenly, I turned around and saw a ground rat's pup with its nose stuck in my side, calmly breathing.

Several people freaked out when they saw it.

No wonder.

They had just been in a fight for their lives with the ground rats, and now they were seeing a baby monster right in front of them.

Apparently frightened by their stares, the pup scurried into my arms.

Gong Pildu asked.

"Why did you bring it here?"

I put my hand on the frightened pup's head and thought.

I could have said I did it out of pity, or I could have said I felt guilty.

I could have plausibly argued that there was no one here today who fought because they wanted to fight, and that would have been the same for the monsters.

"Do you like dogs?"

Gong Pildu was silent for a moment.

As if reading our minds, the pup stuck its head out and looked at him.

Gong Pildu stared at the pup, then asked.

"Will you raise it?"

I hadn't thought about it.

I wondered if I could raise him.

Gong Pildu slowly bent down and squatted.

"Max."

Gong Pildu said in a scary voice. He spoke again, with a slight pause.

"Max."

Then with a whimper and a small cry, the ground rat pup hesitantly crawled out. After a moment's hesitation, it scooted closer to Gong Pildu, sniffed, and wagged its tail.

Gong Pildu's pupils shook faintly. In his wrinkled face, the faintest hint of longing came and went.

I asked.

"Have you ever had a dog?"

Instead of answering me, Gong Pildu stared at the tarp-covered stairwell for a moment.

"A dog would be perfect for guarding the land."

---

After taking the ground rat pup away, Gong Pildu turned to the group and announced.

"We're going to raise this guy."

Max yawned loudly in Gong Pildu's hands.

"As you can see from the way those guys fought earlier, they're very tenacious and strong monsters. We're going to train him and use him as a guard dog. Anyone with a complaint, come out now."

One of the men, who had been glaring at the pup the whole time, held up a hand in frustration.

"What if it isn't well trained and attacks us?"

"In that case, I will be responsible for killing it."

Gong Pildu said firmly, and several men nodded. Some even hesitantly approached and took a closer look at Max.

"The pup is kind of cute in his own way."

"Huh, is that what he'll be like when he grows up?"

Dansoo ahjussi, who was watching the scene from the sidelines, said.

"When Jiyoon stayed in her room and read web novels."

"What?"

"I was in the living room watching old movies."

Dansoo ahjussi, who rarely talks about himself, brought up the topic for the first time in a long time.

"What kind of movies do you watch?"

"King Kong, Godzilla, King Kong vs. Godzilla....."

"Oh."

The daughter read Omniscient Reader in her room, while the father watched King Kong vs. Godzilla in the living room. With a firmly closed door between them.

"When you watch a monster movie, there's always someone who takes pity on the monster and tries to raise it."

"....."

"Every once in a while, Jiyoon would walk by and say something like, 'There are no humans like that. How could people who were about to be eaten a moment ago want to raise the monster'?"

In the distance, Gong Pildu was teaching Max, a ground rat, how to 'give the paw'. Max looked up at him and licked his hand.

"I wish I could have shown her this view."

Gong Pildu frowned, and the people in Chungmuro Station smirked.

People were laughing, like actors backstage after a curtain call. As if everything that happened under that tarp was a lie.

Some people got hurt, some people got killed, but some people laughed.

They know that if they don't, they won't get to play the next scene.

"Mate."

"Yeah."

"I don't want to watch a movie where my mate dies."

I stared at the people laughing and talking, unable to answer.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' has sponsored you.]

[500 coins have been sponsored.]

---

As a reward for risking my life, I was mentally attacked by Kyung Sein for a while.

"Inho-ssi, you're just like Kim Dokja."

"What?"

"No, I mean, who in their right mind would suddenly jump into a swarm of ground rats in that situation? Aren't you actually Kim Dokja? Do you have the King of No Killing or something?"

That comment complicated my feelings quite a bit.

I mean, I like Kim Dokja, but this was kind of.....

—Hey.

There was a small spark in the air, and Bihyung's voice called out.

—Are you up?

Apparently, Bihyung was also waiting for me to wake up.

'Yes, I'm awake.'

Bihyung cleared his throat several times, then continued with a solemn voice.

—I'm really surprised this time. I didn't think you'd start a story.

At the same time as he spoke, the logs that had been pushed aside suddenly appeared.

[You have accomplished an achievement that never existed before.]

[You are beginning your first 'story' in the 3rd scenario.]

[A few constellations doubt your accomplishment.]

[Some constellations are interested in your achievement.]

[A very small number of constellations have noticed your existence.]

[10,000 coins have been sponsored.]

It's an achievement that made the nebulae pay attention to me.

Considering this is only the third scenario, that's quite an accomplishment.

—Don't get cocky. Oh, do you even know what a story is?

'I kind of know. If you collect them, you get stronger.'

—Well, it doesn't matter if you know that now..... Anyway, don't get carried away. You don't have a story yet, just the germination of the first one, okay?

'Yes.'

I couldn't help but smile bitterly, it was as if he was trying to calm down a writer who was excited about an unexpected box office hit.

In fact, as Bihyung said, I couldn't get cocky.

My first story was still a seed, and I wasn't sure if it would ever bloom. And even if it did, there was a chance it would be a bad one.

—You're the worst because you look obedient on the outside. Damn it.

As I listened to Bihyung's rambling, I remembered the beginning of Omniscient Reader.

The novice dokkaebi Bihyung was surprised and horrified by Kim Dokja's behavior.

—Anyway, there will be additional rewards after the scenario is completed, since no other incarnation has solved the 'Emergency Defense Battle' like you.

What kind of ending will this world's Bihyung have?

Will he become the Dokkaebi King of this world?

—Ha, by the way, this is really unusual. I can't believe there are already three people germinating stories.

I paused for a moment, then asked.

'There's other ones?'

Who is it? Yoo Joonghyuk?

—Yes. They're pretty famous now. One dark person, one white person.....

The dark person is definitely Yoo Joonghyuk.

Who is the white one?

'Can you tell me who they are?'

—Naturally, I can't give you that kind of information, but I think they're a little crazy. They keep buying lemon candy from the 'dokkaebi bag'. It costs like 200 coins a piece.

'Lemon candy?'

—Anyway, I have to go. I've got a lot of other noisy places to be right now. Damn, I shouldn't have opened the Hidden Dungeon at a time like this.....

With those words, Bihyung disappeared.

I turned to Kyung Sein, who was still talking about Kim Dokja.

"Sein-ssi. Has Yoo Joonghyuk returned yet?"

"No, and you're still looking for Yoo Joonghyuk. Inho-ssi, you're really—"

"Sein-ssi."

"That bastard didn't even show his nose. Why?"

As far as I could tell, there was only one place Yoo Joonghyuk could have gone if he wasn't participating in the 'Emergency Defense Battle'.

「The Theater Dungeon.」

I had an ominous feeling.

Of course, Yoo Joonghyuk was strong in this world, so he wouldn't die in the 'Theater Dungeon'.

At least, that's how it was supposed to be.

「Yoo Joonghyuk is stuck on the sunfish route again」

That comment from a few hours ago stuck with me.

I glanced at my surroundings and secretly opened my phone. The battery was almost dead.

[A new chapter has been updated!]

A new chapter already?

I absentmindedly scrolled through the list and stopped when I saw the new episode title.

| Episode 10. Writer (1) |
| --- |

As soon as I saw the title, Bihyung's words ran through my head.

「They keep buying lemon candy from the 'dokkaebi bag'.」

I absentmindedly shoved my hand in my pocket.

Since when?

In my pocket, there was something I'd never put there before.

「Take it. And.....」

Too late, I remembered the words from my dream.

I took the object out of my pocket. Slowly, a chill ran down my spine.

A small candy wrapped in a yellow shell.

Surely, that's what Kim Dokja said.

「Give it to him.」

---

Author's Note

Sorry.

Due to health issues, we will be taking a one-day break on Monday (24th) ㅜㅜ

We will be back after a quick recovery.

Thank you!

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

# 600 Episode 10. Writer (1)

Half an hour later, I hunted down the 'Giant Centipede' and organized the items I obtained.

[Giant Centipede Core].

[Giant Centipede Carapace Fragment].

I managed to grab these two items in a hurry.

I didn't have any use for them right now, so I put them up for sale on the exchange through Bihyung.

The centipede's core is used as an ingredient for the panacea, so there was a chance that Chinese incarnations like Fei Hu would buy them.

Come to think of it, I completely forgot about the overseas side.

There are translations of 'Omniscient Reader' in foreign languages, so maybe there are some transmigrated foreign readers.

"Inho-ssi, we're ready."

I turned around to find Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi waiting for me.

"Okay. Let's go."

We went straight to Ye Hyunwoo.

When we told him what we wanted to do, he had the expected reaction.

"You want to go to the Theater Dungeon now?"

Ye Hyunwoo thought for a moment, then asked Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi to leave for a moment.

When they stepped back, Ye Hyunwoo asked in a low voice.

"Does this have anything to do with Yoo Joonghyuk?"

As expected of the 7th Apostle.

I simply nodded and replied.

"Because the only place Yoo Joonghyuk can go right now is the 'Theater Dungeon'."

"Hmm, I guess so too."

Ye Hyunwoo's gaze drifted upward toward the top of the station.

Somewhere up there, Yoo Joonghyuk, who had entered the theater, was probably slashing at monsters.

"I heard from Sein-ssi last time. The Yoo Joonghyuk of this world is the 41st turn, right?"

"That's right."

"Which 41st turn?"

"If you ask me which one."

"There were two 41st turns. One before Shin Yoosung became the Disaster of Floods, and one after."

I smiled bitterly to myself.

This was no ordinary reader, indeed.

My expression must have been serious, because Ye Hyunwoo laughed.

"You can pretend like you don't know, and I won't bother using Lie Detection."

I felt a little numb as I watched him smile.

What a clever reader.

"Probably the former."

"Then it's the '41st turn' from Omniscient Reader. The one where he failed the scenario and turned Shin Yoosung into the 'Disaster of Floods'..... and you're still going to the 'Theater Dungeon'?"

I was at a loss for words.

"You saw him yourself, Inho-ssi. He destroyed all the green zones and tried to kill us."

It was true. We were almost wiped out in the Emergency Defense Battle because of Yoo Joonghyuk.

However.....

「"If you're really Cheon Inho, you can do this alone."」

If I think he did it because he believed in me that much, I wonder if I'm putting too much hope into it.

"If you go to the Theater Dungeon now, you might end up fighting Yoo Joonghyuk."

"I know, but I'm going anyway."

Ye Hyunwoo sighed and asked.

"Will the three of you be alright? Would you like some reinforcements?"

"Are you going to help me?"

"We can't afford to lose Inho-ssi in a place like this. And."

Ye Hyunwoo added hesitantly.

"I saw Inho-ssi talking to Yoo Joonghyuk on the railroad tracks. I don't know what happened between you two, but Inho-ssi seemed to be on the same page with Yoo Joonghyuk."

I've never thought about it like that.

"We're okay. I'm sorry if it seems like I'm leaving you to do the finishing touches, since the scenario isn't even finished yet."

"No, I was planning on passing on the Theater Dungeon anyway. It's hard enough to organize the rewards here, and..... I've already received enough support."

Apparently, Ye Hyunwoo has gotten quite a few coins with his new tech tree, 'Infinite Uroboros' or something.

Apparently, he hasn't even picked a sponsor yet, so he won't have to worry about sponsorship for a while.

I can't wait to see what he picks the next time we meet.

"By the way, I was surprised that Inho-ssi used the 'Poison Bomb'."

I didn't understand Ye Hyunwoo's words for a moment, as his voice lacked the slightest hint of hostility.

"I thought the recipe for that bomb was still only known to the Misreading Association."

Ye Hyunwoo's eyes were calm as he looked at me. I answered, pretending to be calm too.

"I picked one up the last time I was with Killer King against the Misreading Association."

Ye Hyunwoo smirked.

"It's not that I think Inho-ssi is from the Misreading Association, I just....."

I was a little nervous.

Did Ye Hyunwoo see me use the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything'?

Even though the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' wasn't an item that appeared in Omniscient Reader, Ye Hyunwoo's perceptive mind could have picked up on something in that moment.

"Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"If you don't mind, can you get me an item from the fifth floor of the Theater Dungeon? I'll buy it."

"What?"

Look at this.

"What item do you want?"

The fifth floor of the Theater Dungeon is the [rewards room] where the replica items are located.

After thinking for a moment, Ye Hyunwoo said.

"It's the 'Divine Weapon (神機箭)'."

Amazing. I know what it is.

The question is.

"But I don't know if that item is there....."

"I'm sure it does. It was in a movie too. It wasn't in Omniscient Reader, but there's no way it isn't there, it must be there."

Speaking seriously, Ye Hyunwoo glanced at the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' wrapped in my arm and added.

"Because that's what I need for the '5th stage of the Invincible Castellan tech tree'."

What a clever reader.

---

"What were you talking about with the Apostle?"

"Nothing much. He isn't going to the Theater Dungeon himself, so we agreed to get some items for him while we're there."

"Aha."

I briefly recounted the story to Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein.

"You did well, it can't hurt to have a good relationship with the 7th ranked."

"I agree."

My thoughts were the same.

After all, Ye Hyunwoo didn't seem like a bad guy.

"Okay, so now....."

I turned to my last colleague, who was staring blankly into space.

"Heewon-ssi."

Jung Heewon, who was sitting on a bench, looked up with difficulty. For some reason, her expression was strangely grim.

"Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"I'm sorry."

"What?"

The sudden apology caught me off guard. The reason quickly became apparent.

"If only I was a little stronger."

Jung Heewon scratched the subway floor with the tip of her ground rat knife. She must have been doing it for some time, the bottom of the bench was all scratched.

"That's vandalism."

It was a joke, but it didn't work very well.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' feels guilty about you.]

Guilt. Perhaps she was blaming herself for not being able to save me.

"Heewon-ssi."

I knelt down on one knee and grabbed Jung Heewon's hand holding the sword with both hands. Her hand was rough and firm from who knows how many times she had swung the sword by now.

I carefully took the sword from her hand and began to draw on the subway floor. Using Jung Heewon's scratches as a guide, I drew a human face. I also drew a small speech bubble next to it.

「ㅠ ㅠ」

When I finished, you couldn't tell if it was a person or a dumpling.

Jung Heewon stared down at the graffiti and muttered.

"You said it was vandalism."

I looked at her and said.

"You're not the one who should feel sorry right now."

Jung Heewon did her best.

It was me who fell short.

「All '■■' tells me about is 'my danger'.」

Looking back on it now, it was a dizzying situation. What if there had been a more powerful beast than the giant centipede?

「Jung Heewon could have died.」

Just thinking about it made my heart go cold. Maybe I was getting too carried away by the story.

I'm not Kim Dokja.

I'll never be as lucky as he is, or as loved by the stars.

But I have to keep living on this story.

"We're colleagues."

"....."

"I'll be strong enough to not need you to protect me. I won't hide behind you forever."

Jung Heewon's eyes shook as she looked at me.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' is sad because of you.]

Sad?

I quickly added as I handed her back the ground rat knife.

"But this means that I'm going to hide behind Heewon-ssi for a little while longer until I get stronger."

Jung Heewon opened her mouth a little.

"....."

[The character 'Jung Heewon' is delighted by your words.]

[Your understanding of the character 'Jung Heewon' has increased.]

I understood Jung Heewon's situation.

Perhaps this is how she can endure this crazy world.

"So, this is why I need your help again, Heewon-ssi."

"Where else are you going?"

Jung Heewon asked as she wiped her ground rat knife clean with a piece of cloth.

She had just killed a giant centipede with that worn-out sword.

No matter where she is, Jung Heewon is Jung Heewon.

Come to think of it, she had switched to a new weapon around this time in 'Omniscient Reader'.

"I'm going to the theater upstairs."

"Theater? At this time?"

"You should change your weapon sooner or later. There are some good items upstairs, so why don't you come with me?"

Kyung Sein interjected and quickly changed the subject.

"Oh, that's why you're going? But I'm fine with my sword."

"Oh, that girl, Lee Jihye, was carrying a decent one too."

As we headed upstairs, a figure stopped us at the ticket gate.

I didn't have to ask who it was.

"Lee Jihye."

Lee Jihye, leaning against the vending machine, glared at me.

"Huh. What."

"Thanks for earlier."

Her eyes shook, as if she hadn't expected to hear that.

"I was just doing you a favor."

Then she turned away.

A child will be a child.

"You saved the others, too."

I saw it clearly, even in my desperation.

Lee Jihye, who acted as if she wouldn't do anything to help, was saving people from dying in the meantime.

Times change, world lines change, but the essence of a person doesn't change much.

"You should come with us."

"Where?"

"Where your master is."

"Master..... Do you know where he is?"

"I know."

Lee Jihye's eyes were filled with agitation.

"Yoo Joonghyuk didn't tell you anything?"

Lee Jihye didn't answer, but bit her lip hard.

「Yoo Joonghyuk went to the Theater Dungeon, but he left Lee Jihye behind?」

It's a decision I don't understand.

Lee Jihye's sponsor is the 'Admiral Yi Sunsin', and there are many places in the Theater Dungeon where naval battles are staged, but Yoo Joonghyuk left Lee Jihye alone.

It's not the 3rd turn, but the 41st turn.

Even when Lee Jihye died,

「"In the future, sea battles will be a bit difficult."」

Yoo Joonghyuk said that.

"Just..... He told me to stay here and make sure you don't die."

"Why?"

"I don't know. Maybe because he trusts me?"

That's what she said, but there was no conviction in her voice. I don't know the exact situation, but it was an opportunity for me.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 6' has been activated!]

I'll do my best villainous impression for a moment.

"So your mission is over at the end of the 'Emergency Defense Battle'."

"That's true, but....."

"Yoo Joonghyuk is so selfish, right? Treating you like a child, doesn't he?"

Lee Jihye tapped her tiptoes.

"Shut up. You don't know anything."

"Come with us."

"Why would I....."

"I have information on top-grade items. When I get it, I'll give it to you."

"....."

"Don't you want a new weapon? You've been using a sword too, but if you get a new one, maybe Yoo Joonghyuk will take you with him."

The mention of a sword made Lee Jihye pause for a moment.

"What?"

"It's the sword that's weak, not you."

Lee Jihye bit her lip.

"You're just going out for a while. We'll be back before Yoo Joonghyuk comes back."

The innocent girl nodded slightly.

[The character 'Lee Jihye' has a slight affinity for you.]

Maybe collecting <Kim Dokja's Company> is easier than I thought?

---

After a while, we arrived at the entrance of the theater.

"Where did unni learn to use the sword?"

"The kendo club at school."

"Wow, I'm self-taught. What do you learn in a kendo club?"

"How to win, but not kill."

Lee Jihye, who had joined our group on a whim, was chatting with Jung Heewon.

Jung Heewon mostly responded bluntly. Lee Jihye liked that bluntness and stuck by her side, unable to let go.

Come to think of it, the two of them had gotten along well in Omniscient Reader.

"We're almost there, everyone, get ready."

[You are approaching the outside region. Be careful not to leave the scenario area.]

The entrance to the dungeon, the first floor, appeared. Kyung Sein muttered.

"I didn't expect to come here again."

It was a strange feeling.

This 'theater' was the same theater where the real-life 'Kim Dokja's Banquet' was held.

[You have found a 'hidden dungeon'!]

[This dungeon has already been discovered by someone. You can't get the first discovery achievement.]

[A new hidden scenario has arrived!]

**[Hidden Scenario - Theater Dungeon]**

Category: Hidden

Difficulty: A-

Clear Conditions: Defeat the master of the Theater Dungeon.

Time Limit: None

Reward: 4,000 coins

Failure: —

[You have entered 'Theater Dungeon'!]

The scenario message sounded like it had been waiting for us.

We went straight to the dungeon entrance.

And the next moment.

"Stop."

Dansoo ahjussi stopped the group. His bugs must have told him something.

"There's someone else besides us."

Suddenly, my ears perked up.

It wasn't just the first basement floor.

I made my way upstairs.

I could hear people's voices on the first above ground floor as well.

Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi looked at me at the same time.

Only Kim Dokja, Yoo Joonghyuk, and some of the prophets entered this 'hidden dungeon' in Omniscient Reader.

Since the world we've been transmigrated to isn't 'Omniscient Reader's', but 'Ways of Survival's', there are naturally no prophets.

"Inho-ssi, are those people....."

"Yes."

At first glance, there were more than a dozen people hiding on the first floor of the basement alone. Counting the above ground floor, the number might be over thirty or forty.

I hardened my expression and said.

"They're all readers."

Author's Note

It's already 600 episodes.

Time has flown by.

Thank you for always being with us.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 601 Episode 10. Writer (2)

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I looked around the theater.

There were seventeen people waiting on the first floor of the basement.

At first glance, they were not ordinary people.

[Someone has used 'Sneak Peek' on you!]

[Someone has used 'Attribute Detection' on you!]

Detection skill messages flew in as if they'd been waiting for me.

They weren't as high-level detection skills as Yoo Joonghyuk's [Sage's Eye], but they weren't easy to get at this early stage. Readers, too, are out of the ordinary.

['Sneak Peek' failed for an unknown reason!]

['Attribute Detection' failed for an unknown reason!]

Of course, they didn't work on me.

I don't know why they didn't work on me. Come to think of it, I can't even see my own 'Attribute Window', so it would be odd if they could see it.

Maybe I do have a [Fourth Wall] after all.

'Fourth Wall.'

I called out inside, but there was no response.

I'm strong-minded, so maybe I just blocked them with my mind?

"Ugh."

Anyway, I noticed those who were affected by the rebound of the skills. There were two people who had strange reactions.

One was an old man leaning against a stall with a pipe in his mouth, and the other was a woman with a long cheolgon[1] on her back.

[NOTE 1]

Perhaps they were the ones who had just used the detection skills.

I quickly checked their information using the [Readers' Comments List].

[Checking the reader's profile information.]

| |
|---|
| ID: barampoong<br>Platform: Textia<br>Total Comments: 31<br>Reader Level: 35<br>Number of Reads: 6 |
| ID: strawberry1137<br>Platform: Series<br>Total Comments: 112 |

Reader Level: 46

Number of Reads: 8

The old man is 0.06 of Killer King.

The woman is 0.08 of Killer King.

Somehow, I ended up evaluating all readers based on Killer King.

I looked at the other readers one by one.

The man standing over there is 0.005 of Killer King, the one next to him is 0.001 of Killer King, and the next is 0.0006 of Killer King..... There were quite a few people who didn't finish the novel.

Other than that, I didn't see anyone with a particularly impressive number of reads.

Everyone's working hard.

"Isn't that Lee Jihye?"

Someone muttered in a low voice.

I looked back at Lee Jihye with a sense of regret.

Lee Jihye couldn't help but stand out, even if they didn't know anyone else. She was described in the novel.

A hood zipped-up and a ponytail. She carried a long sword. Plus, she has a cute face, so they couldn't help but notice.

"Hmm?"

Lee Jihye glared in the direction of the sound, and people quickly averted their eyes.

Kyung Sein whispered to me.

"Do you want me to try talking to them?"

I shook my head.

Kyung Sein is a friendly person, so she wouldn't have a problem getting to know them, but.....

"We'd better be a little cautious here."

So far, I've been lucky. Kyung Sein, Dansoo ahjussi, and Ye Hyunwoo. They've all been good people.

But Killer King's advice is right. As he said, there was no guarantee that every reader would be a good person.

[Oh, that's a lot of people now.]

The theater doors at the back slammed shut, and the voice of a dokkaebi called out from the air.

[Now that the last of you have entered..... Those of you still in the basement, please come up to the first floor.]

'Theater Dungeon' is a hidden scenario.

Originally, the dokkaebi wouldn't intervene.

"There are more people upstairs. We should be careful."

At Dansoo ahjussi's words, we exchanged a quick glance and went up to the first floor.

As we entered the lobby, the first thing we saw was a dokkaebi in a suit.

[Welcome. My name is Paul, I'm an intermediate dokkaebi.]

The intermediate dokkaebi Paul.

He appeared in Omniscient Reader. Messing up the 'Disaster of the Floods' scenario, getting beaten up by Kim Dokja, and being exiled.

It felt strange to run into him in the 41st turn.

[Hmph..... So many people came here this time. We can't even call it a 'hidden scenario' anymore.]

By now, there were at least 40 people in the lobby on the first floor.

[And you guys are a little late. A few hours ago, the people who discovered this theater had already gone pretty far upstairs.]

A screen floated up on the lobby ceiling.

The screen showed the other incarnations attacking the upper levels of the theater dungeon.

—What the hell, it's no big deal, right?

A young man chuckling and slashing at zombies in the movie, his hair dyed white and a tattered school uniform. A dark aura wrapped around a sharp knife.

I realized who he was.

「Kim Namwoon.」

I wasn't the only one who recognized him. Some people covered their mouths to hide their surprise, others widened their eyes.

—Hey, soldier, hurry up and follow me. I'll go up before the captain. If you delay me.....

The 41st turn Kim Namwoon was still Kim Namwoon.

I could see some readers smiling faintly. Others stiffened their expressions.

Both reactions were understandable.

That 'Kim Namwoon' was definitely the Kim Namwoon we know, and therefore a Kim Namwoon that was extremely dangerous.

—Namwoon-ssi. This stage is not just about killing zombies.....

I could tell even though it was just a voice.

It was unmistakably Lee Hyunsung.

The readers' expressions changed one by one. They could finally meet another member of Kim Dokja's Company.

It was then that Kim Namwoon's scream rang out.

—Uaaaak! What!

The screen shook ominously.

A sharp series of squeals.

A white coat fluttering lightly at the end of the screen.

Immediately, the broadcast stopped.

[That's it for the preview.]

Paul laughed in amusement. There was a mild commotion in the lobby.

"Was that..... right?"

"As expected, yes. As long as you manage to get up there somehow....."

"It's a little different from the original development."

I could see where they were coming from.

The 'white coat' is too symbolic an item in Omniscient Reader.

"Inho-ssi. That's Kim Dokja, right?"

Kyung Sein whispered. Her eyes shook with anticipation.

[NOTE 2]

「There might be a Kim Dokja somewhere in this world.」

I can understand that. I don't think there's a reader here who doesn't expect that.

I steeled myself and said.

"This is the 41st turn."

"Well, but what if something happens that we don't know about, and there's a Kim Dokja here—"

"Maybe."

I replied, fiddling with the lemon candy in my pocket.

"And even if he came here like we did, it's not time to get the coat yet, you know."

"Ah. That's right, the Infinite Dimension Space Coat is....."

Kyung Sein's expression turned sour.

"Then who was that person just now?"

"We'll find out when we go up there."

Lee Jihye, who was looking up at the screen from the side, chimed in.

"Ahjussi. Let's go quickly. I don't want to lose to that guy."

I wondered who 'that guy' was and asked.

"Kim Namwoon?"

"What. How do you know his name?"

"He looks like that."

"No, what—"

I looked at Paul, the intermediate dokkaebi.

He had to show the video of the upper floors at this time.

And he's adding psychological pressure by emphasizing that we're 'late'. Normally, this would have been an unnecessary performance.

That said.

[As you can see, no matter what you do now, you can't keep up with the incarnations of the upper floors.]

Maybe there's a new scenario I'm not aware of.

[That's why I've organized an event specifically for the latecomers.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' wonders what that is.]

[A constellation who hasn't revealed their modifier is curious.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' worries about the incarnations.]

From the looks of it, I can guess what he's trying to do.

That damned intermediate-grade dokkaebi had started playing games with the owner of this 'Theater Dungeon'.

[Read the scenario description for yourself for more details.]

[A new sub scenario has arrived!]

**[Sub Scenario — Departure of the Cinema Trip]**

Category : Sub

Difficulty: B

Clear Conditions: The staircase of the 'Cinema Trip' will open in the Theater Dungeon. You can use the 'Cinema Trip' to quickly catch up to the starters. Roll the dice, clear the stages, and complete the 'Theater Dungeon' faster than the starters.

Time Limit: —

Reward: ???

Failure: —

* You can team up with up to 3 players to start your 'Cinema Trip'.

*From the 1st floor to the 8th floor, every 'staircase' you can step on hides a [Normal Stage], [Bonus Stage], and [Trap Stage] respectively.

* Each stage has a certain probability of a mission associated with a specific 'movie', and completing that mission awards a 'dice'.

* You can climb stairs equal to the number of eyes rolled on the 'dice'.

I roughly understood the scenario.

So, it's a kind of movie version of a 'board game'.

We're the pieces of the board game in groups of three, and we roll the dice, and if we get a high number, we go up the stairs. If you get stuck on a stage, you have to complete a mission.

If this is a scenario where you're trying to catch up to the upper incarnations, the stages will be much shorter than the movie.

"It's like Bl■Mar³, right? Ugh, the filtering."

[NOTE 3]

Both Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi seemed to have figured out what the game was about.

So did other readers.

After all, there's no one in Korea who doesn't know this game.

[I'll give you 10 minutes to form teams.]

The incarnations looked at each other in unison.

Those who already had teams seemed intent on participating as they were, while others looked around frantically.

—The two next to you. They're Jung Heewon and Lee Jihye, right?

A voice in my ear made me look around.

[Full Voice.]

I didn't realize that someone had already bought the skill.

—Don't look around.

A high-pressure tone.

I scanned the area out of the corner of my eye.

[Full Voice] is a skill that seals sound with magic and transmits it.

The user of this skill couldn't help but move their lips.

—I don't know how you got the S-grade characters already, but come join our group. There are three of us. Some of us have contracts with narrative-grade constellations, and some of us have S-grade items.

S-grade items and narrative-grade constellations.

Not a bad offer.

If only it hadn't been for the words that followed.

—You, Lee Jihye, and Jung Heewon. I'll take up to three. We can split into two teams and go up together.

It didn't take me long to find the user of [Full Voice], the woman with the cheolgon on her back who had used [Attribute Detection] on me.

—Please think about it and answer quickly. Remember, this is real life, not fiction.

Nickname strawberry1137.

8 reads.

I don't know how she could be so confident after reading Omniscient Reader 8 times.

But then I heard another [Full Voice].

—Do you want to team up?

This time, it was the old man. I could tell just by looking at him. He was the only one mumbling as if he were ventriloquizing.

Nickname barampoong.

6 reads.

—There are two of us. We're fewer in number, but as you can see, I have [Full Voice] and one S-grade skill. I think you're five..... Why don't you join forces with us?

Again, not a bad offer.

By the way, there was already a behind-the-scenes war of nerves; they were meticulous people.

However, they weren't the only readers.

"Excuse me....."

He raised his hand cautiously. He wore a faded sweatshirt and clutched a toothless sword. He looked around, wondering how he'd gotten here.

He glanced around and asked the innocent question I wished he hadn't.

"H-has anyone read Omniscient Reader?"

There was a collective sigh of despondency. Judging by the looks on people's faces, he was going to have a hard time finding teammates. It was then that a group of people walked out from the stalls in the back of the lobby.

"What are you all shaking about? I don't think there's anyone here who hasn't read the novel."

A group of five men and women.

They were the ones I hadn't yet used [Readers' Comments List] on.

The man who seemed to be the leader of the group spoke up.

"It's not a good time to be looking at each other like that."

Several of us gasped at the man's attire.

A white coat and long sword.

Obviously, he wasn't Kim Dokja.

"We're not here to fight amongst ourselves, are we? Isn't the purpose to work together to clear the dungeon? I'm sure you all received the scenario at the Banquet."

He used his deep voice to dominate the room. He was a good talker.

"I don't think you're all planning on getting blown to bits. Have you forgotten what kind of world this is?"

The mood turned sour, and the cheolgon woman, who had been listening silently, asked.

"What are you up to?"

"You mean me?"

The man smirked, as if he were Kim Dokja.

"I'm closer to being a 'Kim Dokja' than anyone else in the world right now."

The cheolgon woman smirked.

"You?"

"Yes."

"Are you that confident?"

Indeed, the cheolgon woman, who had read Omniscient Reader 8 times, arrogantly drew out her cheolgon.

Then the man laughed.

"I'm not just talking about skill."

He drew the sword at his waist.

I could feel Kyung Sein beside me breathing in. Perhaps anyone would have.

A sword broken in half.

A keen reader would recognize the item.

"Broken Faith.....!"

There was a commotion in the hall.

The cheolgon woman narrowed her eyes.

"You think a broken sword is enough to make you Kim Dokja—"

Wuuuuh.

A blue-white glow emanated from the man's sword.

An ether blade.

Someone cried out in surprise.

"P-Purest Sword Force?"

"It's the Purest Sword Force!"

For once, the cheolgon woman's expression stiffened.

The man smiled faintly at her, then slowly turned around.

"It's understandable that you're so frightened. But you don't have to worry."

"W-who are you. You're not even the real Kim Dokja."

"Of course I'm not Kim Dokja."

The man laughed, looking a little sad.

"Probably even 'Kim Dokja' wouldn't know more about this world than I do?"

The man, who had overwhelmed everyone in the room with his performance, casually revealed his identity.

"I'm the one who wrote 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』."

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Author's Note

It's not us.

Readers, we're really sorry. Due to our scheduling mistake, the upload of the series on Munpia was late. ㅜㅜ We will be careful not to do this next time.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: 철곤: I think it's something like an iron rod.

Note [2]: They used "her" now so I'll go back to she/her unless stated otherwise.

Note [3]: Blue Marble Game is a Korean board game similar to Monopoly (Wikipedia).

# 602 Episode 10. Writer (3)

---

The author of Omniscient Reader.

At his words, the room erupted in confusion.

"Really?"

"No matter how you look at it, he's not Han Sooyoung....."

"Then he's the writer of our world line?"

Jung Heewon and Lee Jihye looked like they didn't know what he was talking about.

Lee Jihye asked.

"What are they talking about? Is he famous?"

"I'm going to look around for a while."

"Oh, I'll go with you, unni."

Jung Heewon glanced in my direction and walked away as if she wasn't interested, and Lee Jihye followed.

Come to think of it, there was such a description in Omniscient Reader.

「"In fact, Sungkook and I tried to test some people by saying that this was a novel. But they didn't understand at all. It is like they're NPCs... No matter how serious I am, they just take it as a joke."」

When the prophets told the characters about 'Ways of Survival', they acted like they didn't understand.

Maybe that's why Jung Heewon and Lee Jihye aren't showing much interest right now.

Kyung Sein, who was watching, quickly came to my side.

"Is he really the writer?"

A man wearing a plausible white coat and carrying a sword that's supposedly 'Broken Faith'.

The white coat could have been picked up somewhere, and the sword could have been acquired quickly enough.

In other words, those items don't provide any guarantee that he's a writer.

But I wasn't convinced he was lying.

It's possible that I'm not the only writer who has been transmigrated. For example, he could be an 'Omniscient Reader' writer from another world line.

Luckily, I had a way to verify that.

[Using 'Readers' Comments List' on this person.]

At the next system window that popped up in front of me, I doubted my eyes.

Huh? Wait a minute.

This asshole.....

While I was checking his information with [Readers' Comments List], Kyung Sein unexpectedly stepped forward.

"Writer-nim, I sent you an article on how to stretch. Do you remember?"

Yes, he had sent me one of those.

The writer replied.

"That..... I don't remember all the messages either. It's only one message from you, but I have thousands of other messages to read."

It wasn't something I said that much, but if you send me something in a direct message, like how to do a stretch, I'll remember it.

I still do those stretches from time to time.

"I'm sorry I don't remember."

"D-don't worry."

Kyung Sein lowered her hand with a grimace.

The self-proclaimed writer added.

"But if I had known it was from such a beautiful woman, of course I would have remembered."

"Huh?"

Kyung Sein looked dumbfounded.

It gave me goosebumps in more ways than one. I should probably say something to save face.

"Are you really the writer?"

The cheolgon woman took the lead.

"How are you going to prove it? You don't have to be the writer to get something like 'Broken Faith'."

True. That's right.

"If you're really the writer, shouldn't you have at least created 'Unbroken Faith'?"

That's..... Not even the real writer could make it.

The asshole writer replied.

"Even if I'm the writer, I can't control every situation, which is why I didn't get the 'random item box'. Maybe one of you here used it."

Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein glanced back at me at this logical statement.

"Wouldn't we be able to tell if we used [Lie Detection]?"

The person who said that was the one who shouted out 'has anyone read Omniscient Reader' earlier.

A few readers shook their heads.

"Oh, right. [Lie Detection]."

"But I wonder if anyone has that skill right now....."

Seeing as how no one else stepped forward, I don't think there's an incarnation with [Lie Detection] here.

That said, Apostles like Killer King and Ye Hyunwoo were the exception.

Normally, no one would have gotten [Lie Detection] at this time.

But the writer signaled to the woman beside him.

She had a big hood drawn and her face covered with a mask.

[Someone has used 'Lie Detection'.]

The message was heard by everyone.

There was a murmur of surprise.

The asshole writer opened his mouth.

"I'll prove it. I'm the one who wrote 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

The readers were stunned.

"Is it true?"

"You're really the writer?"

Excited voices asked.

But some readers still didn't believe it.

This time, it was the cheolgon woman.

"Wait. Are you really the writer who wrote for 'Sirius' and 'Textia'? Say it one more time."

But even the cheolgon woman's tone had changed; she was flustered.

"That's right. Verify it again!"

"She just verified it. I think he's really the writer."

Even the readers began to disagree.

In the center of the debate, I saw the writer with a sour look on his face.

"I know you won't believe me no matter what I say. There's no point in me proving it over and over again."

He sighed softly and slowly looked around.

If nothing else, he was a good actor.

I wonder where they teach how to talk like a writer these days.

"I can promise you one thing, though: if you stick with me from now on, I'll take you to the end of the story, no matter what it takes."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

As if on cue, the asshole writer added.

"I have more complete information than anyone else about Omniscient Reader. If you will trust me, I will lead you down a path where there are no wrong answers."

There was a brief silence in the room.

Stirred, the readers looked at each other.

"He must be for real."

"Well, if it's [Lie Detection], I can believe it."

"Isn't that enough proof?"

"Wait, you believe that easily? [Lie Detection] isn't always accurate—"

There were still a few voices of disbelief, including the cheolgon woman, but the tide was slowly turning in the writer's favor.

Perhaps it was time to step in.

"I'm curious, writer-nim."

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.6' is activated!]

At my words, the readers turned to look at me at the same time. No wonder—my Incite was now level 6.

Even if I farted, everyone would stare at me.

"You're not even Han Sooyoung, do you really have 'perfect information' about this world?"

The readers suddenly had keen eyes as if they smelled a fart.

"Come to think of it—"

"Wasn't it a setting that you were just dictating what Han Sooyoung wrote about Omniscient Reader?"

The writer's complexion changed with the creeping public opinion.

I added, as if letting go of the leash.

"Oh, but since you're the writer, you might know something we don't, for example..... the identity of 'RepresentativeKimDokja'."

The sound of someone breathing in quietly.

The writer replied.

"Unfortunately, I don't know that much either."

That's good. He can say he doesn't know something he doesn't know.

Because you can't prove it with [Lie Detection].

But he made one mistake.

"Hmmm. You don't know that either. You do know more about 'Omniscient Reader' than us, right?"

I could see the corner of the writer's mouth twitch.

"Of course."

"Well, then, do you mind if I quiz you on a few quick Omniscient Reader trivia questions that I'm sure you'll know?"

Slowly, his eyes moved upward.

He was probably looking at 'the manuscript' in his head.

"Sure."

"Okay, here's the first question. In 'Ways of Survival', Yoo Joonghyuk regresses 1,863 times. What does the number '1,863' symbolize?"

"What?"

For the first time, the guy's complexion changed.

"What do you mean symbol, that's....."

"You don't know?"

Of course you don't. Because I didn't either.

"Since you don't know, I'll give you the answer: 1,863 is the year that the world's first subway opened."

I heard a muffled laugh nearby.

Presumably, some of them had attended 'Kim Dokja's Banquet' that day.

The writer protested.

"How do you get a question like that right?"

"Well, if that was too hard for you, I'll give you a second, easier one: How many times does ■ appear in total in the entire 'Omniscient Reader'?"

The laughter around us intensified.

Finally, the writer's eyes narrowed.

"Are you trying to play a joke?"

That's right. I've been making fun of him so far.

It's the last question that counts.

"Was that too hard for you? Then I'll give you one last question, and if you get it right, I'll acknowledge you as the writer. It's a really easy one, and the answer appears in 'Omniscient Reader'."

"I hope it's a proper question."

"Okay, third question. The rest of you may know the answer, but you're not allowed to guess."

I glanced around at the readers, then said the final question.

"How many turns does it take for Yoo Joonghyuk to realize that if he uses the 'Absolute Throne' even once, he will not be able to reach the end of the scenarios?"

A few readers looked like they knew the answer.

It was a question that the hardcore readers would know.

It was also a question that the author of 'Omniscient Reader' would never know.

The writer replied with a wry smile.

"14 turns."

I clapped my hands.

"Wow, that's great."

"So now—"

"I heard you."

A small chattering sound.

The asshole writer frowned and said.

"What..... it's really the 14th turn. I didn't hear it. It's from chapter 72 of 'Omniscient Reader'."

"That's right, it's from chapter 72."

I continued with a low sigh.

"Or, to be more precise, it appears in the 'unrevised manuscript' of chapter 72."

I could see his expression slowly harden.

"That information was a typo, and there was even a correction notice posted later. Yoo Joonghyuk learns the secret of the 'Absolute Throne' in the 41st turn, not in the 14th turn."

The mood in the room quickly turned cold.

"I'm curious, why do you remember it as an 'unrevised manuscript' version, when you even wrote the revision notice yourself?"

The white-faced writer twitched his lips for the umpteenth time before opening his mouth.

"Well, that was....."

At this point, it no longer mattered if he was the writer or not.

Because the pompous 'writer' didn't know any more about 'Omniscient Reader' than the average reader.

As soon as I saw the look in his eyes, I knew what was coming.

"How can you believe that? There's no one here who remembers such information, who are you?"

"I."

Why do I remember it? I could tell them right now, very simply, but I didn't want to.

Because this is not a 'writer's' story.

"I've read Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint over a hundred times."

The writer smirked.

As if no human being could be so ridiculous, he signaled to the woman beside him.

And the next moment.

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

Everyone opened their mouths in disbelief.

I opened my mouth to join in.

"You don't have any exclusive information, and even the information we've heard..... that makes me wonder."

I glanced at the readers, then at the writer, smirked, and asked.

"What the hell did you write?"

---

[The 'Cinema Trip' will begin in 1 minute.]

While I was checking the equipment, a few readers came over to greet me.

"You were amazing earlier."

"Did you really read it over 100 times?"

I responded with only a light smile.

In the distance, I could see the writer's face glaring at me.

I remembered the information from the list I'd seen about him.

ID: tls456

Platform: Sirius, ??? (abnormal path)

Total Comments : 0, ??? (abnormal path)

Reader Level : 8, ??? (abnormal path)

Number of Reads: 1 time, ??? (abnormal path)

* This reader read 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 through an abnormal path.

I know the content, but the platform, total comments, reader level, and number of reads are not displayed correctly.

Crucially, it even said that he took an 'abnormal path' to read 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

My conclusion is this.

「That guy is from the Misreading Association.」

He wasn't even a normal member of the Misreading Association.

This is because what he said about being 'the one who wrote Omniscient Reader' was proven to be true through [Lie Detection].

In other words,

[The constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' glares at you.]

He was the one who uploaded the text to illegal sites.

---

Author's Note

You!

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 603 Episode 10. Writer (4)

The person who uploaded illegal files pretended to be a writer.

I don't know what the hell this world has come to.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' encourages you anyway.]

The reason why he was able to avoid [Lie Detection] was probably because he directly typed "Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint."

Can he say he "wrote" that?

I thought the decision of [Lie Detection] was absurd, but I suddenly felt funny.

「Then what about me?」

Touching the lemon candy in my pocket, I thought about the real author of this story.

「How much can I say I wrote this story?」

[The 'Cinema Trip' will begin soon.]

Looking back, Jung Heewon, who had finished preparing, asked me.

"Are we going alone?"

"Yes."

I briefly looked at the other teams. Most of them had filled the three-person limit.

Until the very end, the [Electrical sound] filled with regret lingered in my ears.

—Are you really not going to join us?

—Sorry. Looking forward to the next time.

It was a woman with a steel helmet and an old man with a pipe.

Both teams had excellent power, but if they teamed up, problems could arise in the future scenario.

Above all,

"Let's see if we survive."

I can't take care of Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi.

"Take care of yourself too, ahjussi."

The two formed a team of three with Lee Jihye.

"If you can't follow me, I'll throw you away."

"Hey, I'll work hard to follow you!"

Lee Jihye was gruff on the outside, but had a lot of affection in her heart.

Just like in the "Emergency Defense Battle," Lee Jihye would not ignore the crisis between the two.

Of course, the skills of Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi are not weak anymore.

There is probably only one old man with a sacred relic of a constellation here.

[Hmm, it looks like everyone is ready.]

The dokkaebi Paul reappeared with the sound of tsutsutsutsu.

[But I see some people who haven't found their own team yet…]

Paul added, taking a light scan of the lobby.

[If you don't have a team, you don't have to worry too much because it's a random match.]

Random matching?

[Entry will now begin.]

[You have been appointed as the team's representative.]

[Jung Heewon has joined your team.]

[Jung Jaewoo has joined your team.]

I felt embarrassed. I deliberately didn't accept team members, but I never thought it would be a forced match like this.

"Um, excuse me... hello."

A man with a familiar face awkwardly lowered his head and approached.

Perhaps he is Jung Jaewoo.

"It seems like we're on the same team... I'll take good care of you."

Upon closer inspection, it was the reader who shouted to people earlier, "Has anyone read Omniscient Reader?"

I felt sorry for him, as if he was shouting out the same words alone, like Kim Dokja, who was always recommending "Ways of Survival."

Of course, you can't believe it just by looking at it.

[The 'Readers' Comments List' is activated!]

ID: rala99

Platform: Series

Total Comments: 103

Reader Level: 19

Number of Reads: 1.62 times

* You can use coins to check comments written by the reader.

* Currently, the number of comments that can be checked for free is 3.

First of all, there is nothing special about the profile, so I went straight into checking the comments.

I'm here to get free cookies~

—(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Chapter 1)

It's said that there's an event, but is it free until here??

—(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Chapter 50)

I've used up all the cookies I received~~ But I'll keep reading~~

—(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Chapter 102)

I was at a loss for words for a moment.

"Jaewoo-ssi, right? I look forward to it."

"Please take good care of me too."

Jung Heewon, who was watching from the side, also gave a short greeting.

Jung Jaewoo may have recognized Jung Heewon, and he lowered his head with a face of regret.

"Me too! It's an honor!"

Rather than teaming up with a stupidly dangerous person, a naive person like him might be better.

Then, a small dice appeared in front of my eyes.

[Roll the dice.]

I held the dice lightly.

The readers around me who threw the dice first spat out swear words.

"Ah, damn it."

"Is it 1 right from the start?"

A dark color hovered over the 10 dice that came out. As you can see, the color of the dice changed depending on the number on the dice.

I stared at the dice.

If the scenario had progressed further, I could get help by obtaining the [God of Dice], a narrative-grade story.

"I'll throw it at once."

After briefly exchanging glances with the party, I threw the dice.

"Oh?"

The dice glowed golden.

[The number on the dice is 6.]

Jung Heewon widened her eyes.

"Are you lucky?"

[Go up the stairs 6 steps.]

[Double Chance! You may roll the dice one more time.]

I threw the dice again.

[The number on the dice is 5.]

[Go up the stairs 5 steps.]

[You have reached the second floor!]

Is 10 steps equal to one floor?

I didn't expect to come to the second floor at once.

Even the luck didn't end there.

[Enter the bonus stage!]

[Each person gets a bonus of 1,000 coins!!]

[An additional dice chance has been obtained!]

The dice appeared again. I rolled the third dice.

[The number on the dice is 5.]

[Go up the stairs 5 steps.]

[Enter the normal stage!]

[There are no assignments for this stage.]

[After 3 minutes, an extra dice chance will be given.]

Does this make sense?

It was an incomprehensible level of luck. As soon as I started, I could roll the dice four times in a row.

Jung Heewon asked in surprise.

"Are you suddenly possessed? Are you good at this kind of game?"

In terms of luck, I was generally unlucky.

I had never won a common comment event or cash event once.

"Hmm… I think."

There are no incidental stories in the <Star Stream>.

In other words, if strange luck suddenly came to me in a row, there must be a probable reason for that luck.

So for example…

"Jaewoo-ssi."

"Yes."

"Do you have any passive skills?"

"Ah."

Jung Jaewoo slightly rolled his eyes and scratched his cheek awkwardly.

"That… can I tell you…"

"If that's a problem, you don't have to say anything."

Was he more cautious than I thought?

Seeing that he practiced Kim Dokja's maxim well, he may have read the entire novel pretty seriously.

"Oh, no. I'll tell you. It's not a skill… I have a trait called [Little Luck]."

I was surprised the moment I heard the characteristic name.

[Little Luck]

Needless to say, it was literally a trait that maximized trivial luck.

「Should I give even the smallest luck to Kim Dokja?」

It was a feature I was worried about.

There was a time when I thought what it would be like to let Kim Dokja grow while evolving his characteristics from [Little Luck] to [Compliant Luck] and [Extreme Luck].

「"Author-nim, there are so many main characters who solve it with luck these days…"」

It was discarded with one word of Ji Eunyu…

But I never thought there would be a reader with that characteristic.

"I don't know why, but I was originally a little bit lucky."

Jung Jaewoo smiled brightly and began to tell stories I hadn't asked about.

"When I go to buy bread, there is always one bread left that I want. Or, when I encounter a question I don't know the answer to, if I take it, I get it right… It's not that great, but small luck keeps following me."

With a shy face, Jung Jaewoo continued to speak.

"So, even after coming here, I was lucky enough to survive several times. I also found a bug on the subway…"

The story of how he evacuated to the ground to avoid a riot at Cheonggu Station, and the brother and sister he met there gave him Elain Monkey Lungs (probably the Killer King siblings).

"I asked them to come with me, but they refused."

He went to the basement of Yaksu Station with his lungs bitten and encountered alien species, and luckily escaped with someone's help (it seems that he met the Misreading Association).

"I almost died then."

After running away to the ground again, this time he met a rhinoceros in Sindang, and the story that someone killed the rhinoceros and left (Is it Yoo Joonghyuk?).

"The 4 knives were so fast that I couldn't see any of them."

Anyway, after running away so hurriedly, it was even said that when he came to his senses, he was at the Chungmuro Theater before he knew it.

"There are a lot of readers here, so I feel relieved."

I blankly looked at Jung Jaewoo.

There really are people like this.

A really lucky man.

"Hey, but can we just talk about this?"

Jung Jaewoo, who belatedly covered his mouth, looked at Jung Heewon.

Fortunately, instead of listening to Jung Jaewoo, Jung Heewon was scouting the empty second-floor lobby.

Jung Jaewoo, slightly relieved, asked again.

"That person… Is she the Jung Heewon I know? Right?"

"You're right."

"Omg!"

Jung Heewon, who was far away, looked over because he had screamed so loudly.

"What's going on?"

"It's nothing."

Jung Jaewoo could not calm down easily and gasped for breath. He asked:

"Have you met the other members of Kim Dokja's Company by any chance? I saw Lee Jihye as well. Did you see Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk—"

"Hey, Heewon might get confused, so let's not talk about this right now."

"Oh, sorry."

Jung Jaewoo lowered his head with a sullen face, and I felt a bit sorry for him.

[A new dice has been created!]

I handed him the dice to change the subject.

"Will Jaewoo-ssi throw it this time?"

"Um, is that okay?"

"Yes."

Jung Jaewoo nodded with a smile.

"Here goes, I'll throw it!"

Jung Jaewoo shouted vigorously and rolled the dice.

[The number on the dice is 5.]

[Go up the stairs 5 steps.]

I was expecting a 6, but a 5 wasn't too bad.

With this, the total number of dice rolls is 21.

Are we going to the third floor at once?

I might be lucky to have met Jung Jaewoo here.

[Fell into the 'trap stage'!]

[Go down the stairs by 3 steps.]

Huh?

[Enter the normal stage.]

Didn't [Little Luck] work this time?

"Get ready."

[You can clear this stage by watching the movie's ending.]

[The difficulty of this stage is high. Upon clearing the stage, a 'ladder' is provided.]

[This stage is shared with the first runners.]

In the blink of an eye, a landscape of greenery unfolded.

I thought I knew where this place was.

Looking around, Jung Heewon and Jung Jaewoo seemed to have noticed the general situation.

The cries of giant monsters could be heard from everywhere.

Somehow, it seemed to be the movie that Kim Dokja and his party cleared in Omniscient Reader.

Jung Jaewoo murmured.

"Oh my god. Hey, is this the movie? Tyranno comes out—"

"It seems so."

If it was really that movie, the difficulty level was high, but I could get quite useful items.

For example, the enhanced ampoule hidden in the central laboratory.

There was just one thing that stuck.

[Share the stage with the starters.]

Obviously, the system messages were phrased that way. In other words, it meant that there was a "starter" who entered this stage before us.

Who is it?

Is it Yoo Joonghyuk?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 604 Episode 10. Writer (5)

It was then that a sharp dagger flew from among the grass.

Jung Heewon, whose complexion changed, pulled out her sword, and I reflexively lowered my back.

The dagger that had missed us by a narrow margin became lodged in a tree.

"I didn't expect you to come all this way already."

Three men and a woman appeared in the dense rainforest.

“Broken Faith” and a white coat.

It was an outfit that made me laugh out loud.

"You are indeed a reader who has read it 100 times."

The Misreading Association’s team of writers.

How did they come faster than us? I thought we were the fastest, but a faint aura swirled around the illegal writer.

[Incarnation, ‘Yeom Ilwoo’, has a proof of receiving the ‘King of Dice’ surname.]

The surname is “King of Dice.”

Apparently, he had the constellation “The King of Gambling” as his sponsor.

Indeed, in that case, it was understandable that he climbed the stage so quickly.

Excluding the illegal writer in the center, the two men and woman were also confirmed by using [Characters List] to confirm the identities of the rest of the gang.

[A large number of people have been browsed and temporarily changed to ‘Character Summary’.]

**[Character Summary]**

Name: Hamin

Sponsor: Snake That Cut Off Its Tail

Exclusive Attribute: Lizardman (Rare)

Overall Stats: [Physique Lv.14], [Strength Lv.13], [Agility Lv.16], [Magic Power Lv.7]

**[Character Summary]**

Name: Kim Jeonhwa

Sponsor: Plague-Bringing Rat

Exclusive Attribute: Ratman (Rare)

Overall stats: [Physique Lv.18], [Strength Lv.16], [Agility Lv. 11], [Magic Power Lv.6]

Both were alien species.

On the one hand, ratman, a member of the family of the “Plague-Bringing Rat,” whom I had dealt with before.

The other is a lizardman, a member of the tail-cutting serpent's family…

Looking at the situation, it was highly likely that the tail-cutting snake was a constellation on the side of the Misreading Association.

I lightly raised both hands.

"Wait. Do we need to fight among ourselves?"

Half of it was sincere.

The last time I met the Misreading Association was when a reader possessed a constellation, and what I killed was his incarnation, a “character.”

However, the member of the Misreading Association I have to deal with this time is a person who possesses a character. No matter how criminal he is for producing and distributing illegal texts, anyway, he is a person from the same reality as me.

I couldn't be comfortable with him being killed by my hands.

Above all, I thought that the punishment for his wrongdoing had to be paid in reality, not in fiction.

Whatever he thought of my words, the guy smiled mischievously.

"That's right. I don't have to fight with the reader who read my novel."

Still brazen.

Thinking about it, I think it would be okay if I just let them pay for their sins here.

"But a reader who has read it 100 times is a bit scary for me."

With a cool tone, the text writer sent a signal.

The two men and woman on both sides threw five or six daggers from their arms.

It looks like we were attacked like that before.

Looking at the blade flying with a clear killing force, I belatedly recalled Killer King's warning.

「"The members of the 'Misreading Association' deserve to die."」

I felt like I knew a little bit why he was so terrified.

As Jung Heewon slashed the flying dagger, the dagger was stuck in the floor oxidized while exhaling black smoke.

The floor in contact with the ammunition turned black. It was poison.

"Be careful! You can't even touch it!"

Last time it was a poison bomb, this time it was poison on weapons.

Tchiiit.

Jeong Heewon's poisoned knife was melting.

"Heewon-ssi!"

I threw the extra knife I had at Jung Heewon. Jung Heewon who received it well raised her sword with both hands and turned toward the front.

A sword wind blew in front of her eyes, and the trajectories of the additional daggers that flew were all broken.

Perhaps feeling that the situation was not going well, the script writer also jumped into battle.

[Incarnation, 'Yeom Ilwoo', activates 'Moonlight Steps Lv. 2'!]

The moonlight steps.

He was running while stepping on the steps with a pretty plausible name, but judging from his movements, his average ability was lower than mine.

The guy who rushed leaving a brilliant light every time was a god who was tamed with hot water.

I hit “Broken Faith” forcefully.

"Change into 'Old Iron Shield'."

At the same time as my command, “Thoughts of Almost Everything” changed into the shape of a shield.

Kagagagak!

The blade bounced off.

The text writer muttered in a surprised voice.

"It's a mysterious item."

The moment I made contact with his knife, a message came through “Thoughts of Almost Everything”.

[The target analysis begins.]

[Item analysis complete!]

[The item is Broken Faith (mass production type).]

[The item's grade is D.]

[The item is rated low.]

[Obtain the mimicry form of the item.]

What is it? “Broken Faith” is not real, but “mass-produced”?

Apparently, the mass-produced knife was no longer usable.

The durability of “Broken Faith” ran out due to the ”Blade of Faith” being activated in front of the readers before.

Perhaps the “Blade of Faith” can't be activated anymore.

The text book writer smiled brightly.

"If I did, would I die?"

A small pot was held by the text writer's side.

['Yongjun' demonstrates the mysterious power of regeneration.]

The Pot of Regeneration, Yongjun.

This time I couldn't help but be surprised.

[D-class item, 'Lesser Leather Greaves', has disappeared as a sacrifice.]

[D-class item Broken Faith (mass production type)'s durability has been regenerated.]

[Broken Faith (mass production type) responds to strong will!]

[‘Blade of Faith', is activated!]

Tchiiing!

A blue ether blade grew from the sword that touched the shield.

Almost reflexively, I dropped my shield and stepped back.

[The mimicry form of 'Old Iron Shield' has been destroyed!]

Both sides almost flew away.

As if he was already confident of winning, he let out a relaxed smile.

"Did you not know how to use this?"

Yongjun is a reward item that can be obtained at the National Altitude Area Museum. It was an item that could never be obtained in the current scenario.

Except in one way.

"It seems that your sponsor spent quite a bit of coins."

"My sponsor is a bit rich."

Towards the script writer who smiled confidently, I replied with a grin.

"How amazing. I don't think that kind of information was written on the illegal text."

The script writer's expression hardened. In the mass-produced “Broken Faith” swordplay, powerful etheric blades began to rage.

I hurriedly avoided the blade and carefully examined his skills.

[Incarnation, 'Yeom Ilwoo', is activating 'Wolyeong River Lv.1'!]

"Looking at it now, it isn't even the [White and Blue Steel]."

I expected that.

The last stock of white and blue steel was already bought by Killer King's younger sister.

The enraged text writer screamed and swung his sword.

[Incarnation, ‘Yeom Ilwoo’, activates 'Wolyeong Sword Technique Lv.2'!]

[Incarnation, 'Yeom Ilwoo', activates 'Weapon Improvement Lv.2'!]

[Weapon Improvement], [Wolyeong Sword Technique], and [Wolyeong River] were all skills that could be acquired in the early stages.

「But with that level of proficiency, it's worth fighting for.」

Along with the dazzling light, the “Thoughts of Almost Everything” had turned into a bamboo pole.

When “Blade of Faith” collided with the bamboo pole and went away with a metal sound, the script writer opened his eyes.

Of course I knew that my weapon would be cut off. “Ether Blade” in the beginning is that powerful.

But that's for a low-level item, and this is a star relic.

[The constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', nods happily.]

The man bit his lip hard and swung his sword right away.

Kagagakak!

The blade and the bamboo pole collided, making a sharp scraping sound.

Contrary to the fact that he was quite talkative, his combat sense was not very good.

Even though he has [Wolyeong River], [Wolyeong Sword Technique], and [Weapon Improvement], he doesn't have the slightest advantage over me.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' admires the poor sword fighting.]

It was natural.

This guy must have been killing enemies in one blow with the one-tool “Blade of Faith.”

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', advises that you should not pour in support from the beginning because of this.]

[The constellation, 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes', clicks his tongue and nods.]

The durability of “Broken Faith” ran out before I knew it, and “Blade of Faith” was broken.

I swung the bamboo stick at the guy's side without missing a chance. He narrowly escaped, but the hem of his coat was torn and flesh peeled off his side.

[The constellation, 'The King of Gambling', is disappointed with his incarnation!]

[The constellation who has not yet revealed his modifier advises you to choose your hand carefully from now on.]

He hurriedly backed away, holding back a high-pitched scream.

“What are you doing! Stop watching and help quickly!"

Along with his cry, the ratman and lizardman that Jung Heewon was dealing with began to react abnormally.

[The constellation, 'Plague-Bringing Rat', increases the synchronization rate with its incarnation.]

[The constellation, 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail', increases the synchronization rate with its incarnation.]

Jung Heewon, who was gradually gaining an advantage with the combo of [Ghost Killing] and [Kendo], closed her eyes.

Tsutsutsutsutsutsutsu!

Blue sparks covered the alien species.

The demonic energy of the alien species, which had been around the 9th level before, had risen to the level of a level 7 monster.

[Incarnation, 'Hamin', activates 'Cursed Dagger'!]

[Incarnation, 'Kim Jeonhwa', activates stigma' and accelerated attack'!]

Dozens of daggers fell like a waterfall from the arms of the two aliens.

Jung Heewon avoided the weapons with light movements.

But this time something was different.

[The special effect of 'Cursed Dagger' is activated!]

I suddenly recalled the effects of [Cursed Dagger].

"Heewon-ssi! Stop it this time!"

The [Cursed Dagger] is a stigma that, if you miss 20 dagger hits, you can definitely be hit by the “next one.”

A black dagger that followed Jung Heewon's movements finally reached her nose.

Jung Heewon swung her sword and slashed it. With the sound of metal, the dagger's blade began to melt.

"Aaaaaaa!"

Jung Jaewoo, who was hiding nearby, screamed as he saw the melted knife.

Jung Heewon, who grabbed Jung Jaewoo by the back, quickly retreated towards me.

"Inho-ssi."

I nodded in agreement.

If this is the case, there is no chance of winning.

Weapons are also weapons, but on the other side, two constellations clung to each other and divided their ranks.

"Jaewoo-ssi, do you have any hidden skills?"

Jung Jaewoo shook his head.

It must be difficult to trust the [Little Luck] this time as well. Because that's literally 'a little bit of luck'.

“Heewon-ssi.”

Jung Heewon nodded.

I gave Jung Heewon 'Samyeongdang's Bamboo Stick' that I was holding and said, "Please lend me your ear for a moment."

I didn't want to use this skill on Jung Heewon. But now there was no other way.

The text writer shouted as if he felt something strange.

"Kill them! Quickly!"

The aliens, whose bodies had more than doubled in size, roared and charged.

Aliens are not “humans.”

Then can you say that they are “monsters”?

I don't know. But what is certain is, "Every enemy you see in front of you from now on."

That it will be like that from now on.

"It's a monster."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.6', is activated!]

The ratman swung his claws that had grown long, and the lizardman swung his tail, aiming for Jung Heewon's back.

And.

[Incarnation, ‘Jung Heewon’, activates ‘Judgment Time’.]

Sparks lit up in Jung Heewon's eyes.

[The constellation, ‘Maritime War God’, doubts his own eyes.]

[The constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', admires the descendant's swordsmanship.]

[The constellation, ‘Abyssal Black Flame Dragon’ asks if the probability is okay.]

What was happening, I couldn't even track it with my naked eyes.

Amidst the rising dust, terrifying cracking sounds resounded in succession.

A flash of light soared with the sound of an explosion, and the severed lizardman's tail and ratman's arm rolled outside the dust.

Less than a minute later, a series of loud banging sounds came from the cloud of dust.

As the dust slowly subsided, only one person's shadow stood there.

I saw the corpses of the ratman and the lizardman torn apart.

It was expected, but the result was more than expected.

[The constellation, 'Plague-Bringing Rat', vomits blood and exits the channel.]

[The constellation, 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail', cuts its tail to avoid the probability aftermath!]

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail', stares dumbfoundedly at 'Jung Heewon'.]

Realizing that the battle was unfavorable towards him, the script writer had already broken through the rain forest.

He was just running away.

Jung Heewon picked up one of the dead ratman's daggers and threw it at him.

Whee-a-a-a-aek!

The weapon flew like a bullet and grazed the guy's shoulder.

"Aaaaaaaaaagh!?"

He screamed and fled through the rain forest.

I couldn't miss him like this.

He is a man who does not hesitate to stab people. Here, he must definitely stop breathing.

At that time, Jung Heewon fell forward. I could see the aura of judgment that had spread over her whole body fade rapidly.

"Heewon-ssi!"

['Incite''s effect has disappeared.]

['Judgment Time' is canceled.]

I hurriedly supported Jung Heewon.

There was no abnormality in her breathing or pulse. However, looking at the nosebleed, it seemed that the aftermath of [Incite] was strong.

"I'll finish him and come back!"

Seeing the situation, Jung Jaewoo jumped up and ran out, probably gathering his courage.

I shouted while carrying Jung Heewon.

"Wait a minute! Jaewoo-ssi!"

Soon, Jung Jaewoo disappeared into the rainforest in pursuit of the script writer.

Anxiety overtook me.

I followed the footsteps of Jung Jaewoo with Jung Heewon on my back.

Several times in the distance, piercing sounds rang out, and screams were heard. I continued to run after the source of the sound.

And… damn it.

"Jaewoo-ssi!"

Jung Jaewoo was lying between the trees.

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier makes a sad face.]

I breathed in lightly and approached Jung Jaewoo.

「Jung Jaewoo has a little bit of luck.」

At least, he won't die of poison in a place like this. The wound must have avoided vital points.

Jung Jaewoo let out a moan as if in pain.

"Ugh."

I laid Jung Heewon on the floor and looked at Jung Jaewoo's wounds.

“Hey, Inho-ssi."

Jung Jaewoo was smiling.

"I… I got… a… shot… at him… He… didn’t… get… far…"

"Don't talk."

A dagger was stuck near Jung Jaewoo's heart. Upon checking his wounds, the poison had already spread from his chest, melting his skin and intestines.

The blood that fell on the ground soaked the floor.

"Stay still."

Why are you hurt so badly?

Jung Jaewoo must have had [Little Luck]?

Belatedly, it came to my mind that the script writer was the incarnation of the “King of Gambling.”

If the two people's luck collided with each other, the effect of the attribute was offset.

"Omg…"

Medicines that could cure this wound came to mind.

Elaine Forest Essence?

Too late to use.

Great Healing Elixir?

I checked the dokkaebi’s bag, but it was already out of stock.

Holy oil or something similar?

There was no way to get it now.

「I couldn't think of a way.」

If there was Lee Seolhwa, she would be able to save him. There’s the Life and Death pills she made.

「She isn’t here now.」

The pages of ORV went through my mind.

I wrote many sentences with my own hands. In the sentences I wrote, there must be a way to save this person.

"It’s alright. I can fix this. Don’t worry."

A person is dying right in front of my eyes.

My hands trembled and my head wasn't working well.

I squeezed out the “Elaine Forest Essence” I had and applied it to the wound along with an ointment cream.

In order to avoid the spread of poison, I cut ground rat jerky into small pieces and fed it to him with horn powder from the poisonous rhinoceros.

Jung Jaewoo's throat wriggled and he started coughing up blood.

Jung Jaewoo muttered while crying.

"I don’t want to die."

"You won’t die."

It's a lie. This person is dying.

My breathing was hoarse, and my voice trembled.

"I’ll save you."

Because of me, the reader who read my story was dying.

"I'll save you no matter what."

In the face of his death, all I could say was a lie.

You won't die.

Even if you die, I can definitely save you.

Jung Jaewoo's lips moved. He seemed to be trying to say something, but his voice was muffled.

He seemed to say he shouldn't have read it, and he seemed to resent the person who wrote it.

After a while. His breathing stopped and his pulse stopped.

[Team member, 'Jung Jaewoo', has died.]

I looked down at Jung Jaewoo's face for a long time.

I've definitely seen people die several times.

「Jung Jaewoo is dead.」

Still, I didn't feel it.

Really, I couldn't believe that the person who was alive a moment ago had passed away.

"Jaewoo-ssi."

The moment I grabbed his limp hand, I felt something transparent coming out of his body.

I realized that it was Jung Jaewoo's soul.

He definitely has a soul.

Then I might be able to save him. If we somehow find out where his soul is, then-

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

Sparks flew in the air, and for an instant the outline of the soul thickened.

There was a terrible scream.

A hand snatched his soul in an instant. It disappeared through the torn space and I watched the scene in a daze.

My thoughts didn't flow as if my head was out of order. I didn't quite understand what it was. The only thing I managed to get out of my messed up brain was a single sentence.

If I'm not mistaken, Jung Jaewoo's soul that disappeared must be—

「He was in the form of a kkoma Kim Dokja.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 605 Episode 10. Writer (6)

Feeling his heart rapidly grow cold, Jung Jaewoo trembled with fear.

「I’m scared. I'm scared. I'm scared. I'm scared. I'm scared. I'm scared.」

Dying. He was dying now.

[Oh, what a pity. It's okay. Don't worry.]

Someone was talking to him while holding the back of his neck.

[You're not going to die.]

A dark, bleak voice.

Jung Jaewoo realized whose voice it was.

It was 'RepresentativeKimDokja'.

[There's a story you need to see.]

A story. When Jung Jaewoo heard that, his heart suddenly beat.

His dying body was reviving.

Was this how Kim Dokja felt when he was resurrected with the power of the “King of No Killing”?

The thoughts that he shouldn't have read the novel disappeared.

I'm glad I read this story after all.

Then he felt his head, hands, legs, and body regenerate.

Jung Jaewoo opened his eyes as much as he could.

He was sitting in front of the movie theater screen.

For some reason, his mind was clouded.

The memories from a while ago flashed through his mind one by one.

The day he went to the theater dungeon, meeting the readers, meeting Cheon Inho and Jung Heewon.

He had a fight with a human claiming to be a writer.

And.

「"Jaewoo-ssi."」

A man's face appeared on the screen. And with his eyes closed, he could see his own body without any movement.

I’m dead.

Oddly enough, he didn't feel sad or distressed. Because the story was still going on in front of his eyes.

「"Jaewoo-ssi."」

Looking at Cheon Inho holding his hand and shaking his body, Jung Jaewoo thought.

As expected, this story is really great.

This story, I want to watch it a little more.

[Of course. You can do that forever.]

RepresentativeKimDokja tapped him on the shoulder and disappeared.

Jung Jaewoo blankly stared at the screen.

On the screen was a grieving Cheon Inho. As soon as he faced Cheon Inho, Jung Jaewoo felt the providence of faraway stories.

He lost himself little by little while swimming in that universe of stories.

Who was I?

But still, looking at Cheon Inho, who was sitting with a despairing face, he wanted to tell him something.

I'm okay. I'm still here, even though I've been dragged into a strange little space, I'm reading this story.

Then a small keypad appeared in front of his eyes.

He stared down at the keypad and wrote a word.

> rlaehrwk41: What kind of thing is this?

Then, a kkoma Kim Dokja, who was next to him, looked back at him.

> rlaehrwk37: New here?

On the chest of the kkoma Kim Dokja was a name tag with rlaehrwk37 written on it.

> rlaehrwk37: I worked hard to save you, but you died.

He casually looked down at his chest.

“rlaehrwk41.”

rlaehrwk41 looked down at his name tag for a while before asking.

> rlaehrwk41: Who are you?
>
> rlaehrwk37: Who is it? Everyone is in the same situation as you. Do you know ‘Daknunsam’ for newcomers?
>
> rlaehrwk41: What's ‘Daknunsam’?

Then rlaehrwk37 said with a serious face.

> rlaehrwk37 : Shut up and watch for three days until you figure out what’s going on.

---

It rained.

Under a dense broad-leaved forest that can escape the rain, I buried Jung Jaewoo's body.

[The constellation, 'Commander of the Red Cosmos', looks at you.]

At his moment of death, Jung Jaewoo was smiling mysteriously.

Why? He said he regretted reading this novel, so why did he die smiling like that?

Could it be the last amount of [Little Luck] influencing him?

[The constellation, 'Demon-Like Judge of Fire', comforts you.]

[The constellation, 'Lily Blooming In Aquarius', sponsors 100 coins.]

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', asks why you bury them when they’ll disappear anyway.]

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon was right.

When this movie ends, this world disappears. Then Jung Jaewoo's body will also disappear.

I know that.

But it was the same everywhere, not just here. The earth, solar system, and the galaxy will disappear someday.

But we bury the dead in the ground. I don't know why.

All I can tell is a story about a novel. Some sentences only become meaningful when they are buried between sentences and not revealed.

Maybe that's what death is like.

Jung Heewon did not wake up right away.

I followed the footsteps of the script writer with Jung Heewon on my back. The footprints were cut off at some point.

There was a jar, “Yongjun”, which was dropped by the broken footprint.

I hung Yongjun around my waist.

If his injuries were enough to drop even his main item, he would be dead or dying somewhere by now.

I stopped tracking the script writer.

[Reach the end of the movie.]

Getting rid of him is important, but for now, escaping from this movie was the first priority. In the end, you have to see the end to return to the original world.

After losing Jung Jaewoo, Jung Heewon also passed out.

If I ever run into the “starter” who was hiding by himself, my team would be doomed.

「We must not lose anyone anymore.」

After covering Jung Heewon with my coat, I continued to walk in the rain. In the middle of the rain and sweat mixed, even the floor was muddy and my steps were heavy.

Groooh!

Occasionally, when I hear the roar of a giant monster, I lean for a moment under the trunk of a tree.

I caught my breath.

The film ends when we escape from this island.

I'll probably have to go to the research center in the center of the island this time too.

[The theater owner hates the mediocre ending.]

Sparks intermittently fell from the gloomy sky.

[The theater owner accepts the proposal of the constellation 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail'.]

[The constellation, ‘Snake That Cut Off Its Tail’, unravels its story.]

[The composition of the stage is partially changed]

[A black moon has risen on the stage.]

[Some monstrosities evolve under the blessing of the constellation 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail'!]

[The constellation, 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes', advises you to hurry.]

With an eerie feeling running down my spine, I hurried my steps. But the research wing was too far, and they were getting closer.

I could see the grass swaying in all directions as if chasing prey.

In the end, I put Jung Heewon down and took the damaged bamboo pole in my hand.

Grrr.

A group of red-eyed raptors emerged from the grass.

[The 8th-grade earth dragon, 'Raptor', reveals its intent to kill you.]

One two three four… eight in total. Each one is a level 8 monster, but when gathered together, they are monsters that can even hunt level 7 monsters.

[Activate the exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.6'!]

"I am a raptor. I am not your enemy"

I tried telling it just in case, but it didn't work.

[The constellation, 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail', smirks.]

The power of someone stronger than the instigation was ruling them.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.6', is activated!]

I smashed the raptor's head with the bamboo pole and amortized it.

「Seeing that '□□' didn't activate, I'm not in danger of dying.」

But what about Jung Heewon?

I aimed my bamboo stick at the surroundings, protecting Jung Heewon who leaned against the trunk of a tree.

Should I spend coins on stats?

Or should I buy a new skill?

[Possessed coins: 25,400 C]

No good method came to mind.

Even if I hunted all the raptors, it was a problem.

The raptors I'm facing now were weak even in this stage.

Quadduk!

Taking advantage of my carelessness, a raptor bit my arm.

I cracked the guy's head with the tip of the bamboo stick. Shaking off the dripping blood, I activated [Incite] once again.

"I am Tyrannosaurus Rex."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.6', is activated!]

"Hmm," I breathed in, and let out the loudest shout I could.

Whoaaaaaaa!

At that moment, the bodies of the raptors who were aiming at me stiffened.

I took a step forward and let out another roar.

Aaaaaaaa!

As the first raptor ran away, the second raptor immediately turned its back. Three, four, five… In an instant, all but the two fighters I knocked down ran away.

[The constellation, 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband', has sponsored you 100 coins.]

I internally let out a sigh of relief.

My throat was sore from the excessive roar.

Go go go…

It was then that the nearby ground began to vibrate.

I had an ominous feeling.

「Is it really because of me that the raptors ran away?」

The broad-leaved trees on the left collapsed, and the front claws of a giant terrestrial dragon appeared.

Oh oh oh oh!

[A 7th grade earth dragon, 'Tyrannosaurus Rex', has appeared!]

In the main story, Lee Jihye, Jung Heewon, and Kim Dokja worked together to catch the monster.

But now, Kim Dokja and Lee Jihye were not here, and Jung Heewon was also in a state of fainting.

Codedeuk!

A huge tail came flying, breaking all nearby trees.

I wrapped my body around Jung Heewon and rolled on the floor.

Blood continued to flow from the arm that had been hit by the raptor.

It was not an opponent that could be defeated in a one-on-one fight.

After all, my main skill is [Incite]. What should I do to [Incite] to scare him?

「How far can I [Incite] this world?」

With all my imagination, I recalled the most powerful dragon I know.

A monster that can't be compared to a 7th grade dragon.

Did they realize what I'm trying to do? There was already a sign of a probability storm throughout my body.

[The constellation, 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail', blinks.]

"I am."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv. 6', is activated!]

I slowly opened my mouth.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', realizes your intentions and is surprised.]

To save Jung Heewon.

And at the end of this theater, to meet Yoo Joonghyuk once again.

"Apocalypse."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv. 6', is being pushed to the limit!]

There was a pain as if all my cells were being squeezed.

Now all I have to do is spit out the last word.

Last one, the last word.

The Tyrannosaurus Rex's front claws moved towards me.

Tsucheucheucheucheucheucheut!

My tongue stiffened as if something was covering my mouth. The last word was not uttered.

I closed my eyes tightly.

「If I die, will I become a kkoma Kim Dokja?」

A flash of light flashed in the pale darkness created by my eyelids. Then I heard a thump and something rolling on the floor.

When I opened my eyes, I saw a clear blue-white ether blade and the Tyrannosaurus, who fell down after losing his front foot.

"What?"

The familiar faces of the brother and sister were seen beyond the brilliant [Purest Sword Force].

Killer King, who had read ORV 99.8 times, was there.

"You, why are you here?"

| |
|---|
| rlaehrwk41: Those are the people who saved me. |

---

Yeom Ilwoo, the script writer, was running while swearing.

'Damn it! Damn it!'

The battle that had just happened was still vivid in his mind. From a madman who said he read ORV 100 times, to a crazy woman who killed a 7th grade alien species.

"Wow!"

A madwoman's throw tore his arm apart, knocking him down, and a newbie chasing after him thrusted his sword into his thigh, making his maneuver difficult.

He had made a hole in the newbie's heart, but thanks to that, he too was in danger of dying soon.

[The constellation, 'King of Gambling', bestows good luck on you.]

What saved him was his sponsor.

Yeom Ilwoo, the script writer, passed through a broad-leaved forest area with amazing luck, avoided a group of dinosaurs, and eventually succeeded in entering the "Central Research Building" first.

He even discovered a "hidden tunnel" that led directly from the research building to the upper floors.

[You are the first to enter the research building!]

[Do you want to enter the "Hidden Tunnel"?]

[When entering the tunnel, the stairs are randomly skipped.]

[50% chance to reach the 3rd floor, 40% chance to reach the 4th floor, 10% chance to reach the 5th floor.]

Yeom Ilwoo entered the tunnel without hesitation.

["King of Dice" is activated!]

[Enter the 5th floor!]

5th floor.

The place where the rewards were located.

Young Ilwoo stepped onto the fifth floor, unable to hide his excitement.

Although he lost two of his teammates and even dropped Yongjun on the way back, luck was still on his side.

Yeom Ilwoo found a woman who arrived on the 5th floor before him.

"Hey, look. Are you alone?"

A short woman in a white coat.

As soon as he checked the woman's face, Yeom Ilwoo's face brightened.

[The constellation, 'King of Gambling', says you can't go that way.]

Yeom Ilwoo ignored him.

No matter who it was, it was an 'incarnation' who was here anyway, and with a high probability of being a 'reader'. And he was confident in deceiving any reader with his words.

There surely can't be two crazy people who've read ORV 100 times.

Above all, the woman's face was beautiful.

"Let's team up together. I am the author of this novel! You heard it earlier, right? 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'—"

As soon as Yeom Ilwoo reached for the woman with a faint smile, an eerie sound split the air.

Yeom Ilwoo did not know what happened until the moment his neck rolled down.

[The constellation, 'King of Gambling', checks his eyes in astonishment!]

[The constellation, 'Sneaky Schemer', glares at the 'King of Gambling'.]

[The constellation, 'King of Gambling', hastily leaves the channel.]

The woman staring at Yeom Ilwoo's head rolling on the floor smiled.

"It's a little bit, but you can't use an avatar?"

The woman lightly brushed off the blood from her sword and looked back after she wiped the blade.

"Hey, you."

"…"

“Kim Namwoon, Lee Hyunsung, aren't you awake yet?"

Kim Namwoon, who was lying behind her, staggered and raised himself. And with a bizarre smile, he said.

"You're really strong. Kekeke. But compared to our leader– Keuhaha!"

Kim Namwoon, who was hit in the back of the head, instantly fainted.

"As expected, you were awake. Don't wake up."

The woman dragged Kim Namwoon, who quietly passed out, and Lee Hyunsung, who suddenly began to snore, upstairs.

"Hey, what floor is Yoo Joonghyuk on?"

When the woman asked, Lee Hyunsung's snoring stopped.

Then the woman said.

"Not you, Lee Hyunsung."

Lee Hyunsung began to snore again, and the answer came from the air.

[The constellation, 'Sneaky Schemer', says he is now on the last floor.]

The woman let out a light sigh, and once again a message was heard in the air.

[The constellation, 'Sneaky Schemer', says everyone is worried.]

"Don't worry."

[The constellation, ‘Sneaky Schemer', is…]

"It's noisy."

After receiving an answer, Han Sooyoung looked at the torn movie posters for a while. These are probably the films that Yoo Joonghyuk ripped up.

「Originally, she had never come to this theater.」

In the third turn, when Kim Dokja cleared the Theater Dungeon, she was somewhere else.

However, she knew what Kim Dokja said here.

「"I made a wish to see the epilogue of a certain novel."」

Did Kim Dokja, who said that at the time, know that this story would be so long?

「Are you still curious about the end of this world?」

Han Sooyoung left the torn poster and looked up at the ceiling.

Maybe Kim Dokja was still reading this story somewhere.

As if talking to Kim Dokja, Han Sooyoung muttered.

"You keep reading from there. Because I'll do my job."

Putting an end to the story, and bringing the reader back to reality.

That was the author's role.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 606 Episode 11. Artwork (1)

These days, whenever I pass out, I have a thought. Maybe I will meet Kim Dokja again this time.

I was always thinking of questions to ask when meeting Kim Dokja.

Where are you now?

Why did you call me here?

What story are you reading right now?

[Current state of consciousness is unstable.]

Unfortunately, when I opened my eyes, it was not a snowy field.

I could see the dark scene of the theater around me. It was a theater where kkoma Kim Dokjas were gathered..

As soon as I woke up, I thought of Jung Jaewoo. At the last moment, Jung Jaewoo disappeared as a “kkoma Kim Dokja.”

Maybe he's here too.

People huddled around the theater and sat down. Small backs of heads were visible.

If it had been before, I would have thought of it as cute, but now a part of my heart felt cold.

Perhaps, aren't these "kkoma Kim Dokjas" all dead readers?

The moment I slowly opened my mouth and tried to call Jung Jaewoo's name,

「"Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Voices came from the speakers in front.

There were two people on the screen. One is Yoo Joonghyuk in a black coat, and the other…

「"Who are you?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk asked, and someone answered.

「"The one who came to finish your story."」

It felt like my heart was sinking.

It cannot be done.

Those two shouldn't fight now.

I have to get out of here right now.

I felt my body slowly disintegrate. My consciousness will be awakened again.

"Wow, the fight of the century!"

At the last moment, I heard the kkoma Kim Dokja beside me shouting like that.

---

When I woke up, Killer King was kicking me with his foot.

"You're a weakling. To think you've lost your mind with just such a wound."

I groaned lightly and got up.

It was a dark night. I could faintly feel the warmth of the bonfire.

It seems that I got help from the Killer King siblings.

"Please eat."

Killer King’s younger sister supported me and handed me a teacup. When I sniffed it, it turned out that it was someone who had put herbs in it and boiled it.

"Thank you."

Judging by the color and scent, it seems that Elaine's “Dawn Dew” or “Baekoncho” was added.

All of them were food ingredients that did not appear in the main story when reading.

"It's not poison, so there's no doubt about it. I won’t do that twice."

"I just smelled it because I liked the smell of tea."

"This is a newly discovered medicine. It's good for restoring mana and mental strength."

Killer King said that and drank it as if to demonstrate.

I felt a strange feeling when I saw a reader who naturally finds material that the author did not write.

Even if it leaves the hand of the writer, the story continues.

「Does Han Sooyoung know about this?」

Along with a faint headache, the dream I had seen before flashed through my head.

As I looked around in a hurry, Killer King said.

"Jung Heewon is over here."

Next to the bonfire, Jung Heewon was asleep under a light blanket. When I put my hand to the tip of her nose, I could feel her breath.

There doesn't seem to be any trauma, but I think it was a mental attack.

Jung Heewon still seems to have not recovered from the aftereffects of [Incite]. I briefly mentioned the situation instead of a detailed explanation.

"I met the Misreading Association."

As expected, Killer King's attitude changed.

"Tell me in detail."

I exhaled lightly and started talking about the gathering of readers under the theater dungeon.

Without even listening to a few words, Killer King quickly grasped the situation.

"Is it. The scenario has changed. Are they considerate of latecomers?"

Especially after hearing that a guy who called himself 'the writer' appeared, Killer King's eyes began to take on an eerie light.

"Author? You said he went with the Misreading Association guys?"

I don't know, but I wonder if Yoo Joonghyuk made that kind of expression when he was stabbed in the back by Anna Croft in the second round.

But Killer King quickly regained his composure.

"You don't know it, but [Lie Detection] can be cheated by adjusting to the speaker's beliefs, or the value of the information being said."

It's something I knew, but I nodded my head once.

"To say that he wrote the Book of Revelation himself… would mean that he wrote the 'illegal text' in the Revelation. In other words, it means that he is not a 'real writer.'"

I was amazed.

"By the way, if it's a illegal text writer… Is he the one after all?"

"Do you know who it is?

"It must be one of the executives of the Misreading Association. I have fought him before. How did it go? Are you sure he has stopped breathing?"

"He's probably dead. He was seriously injured."

Killer King nodded his head approvingly.

"I roughly understood the situation. You managed to survive."

"When did you two come here?"

"Half a day outside. Based on this stage, it was two days ago."

Perhaps this stage had a different time scale than the outside.

If it's half a day outside, did it come around the time the 'Emergency Defense Battle' started?

"With the two of you, it wouldn’t have been a movie that would have taken two days."

"We also met the Misreading Association."

"The Misreading Association?"

I belatedly realized my mistake.

Why did I think the Misreading Association would only be among the “latecomers”?

They must have read the exhibition through the illegal text, so the quick-witted ones among them must have infiltrated the theater dungeon beforehand.

"The number were five in total. As soon as I entered the stage, I met them. Two were rats, and three were snakes. I killed them all, but the problem was that the snakes bit me as they died."

Saying that, Killer King showed his arm.

There were traces of a snake's teeth on his pale arms, and a purple mark was engraved around the teeth marks.

"It's a curse."

"Right."

"What curse?"

"The Curse of Disorientation."

It reminded me of a setting I had memorized sometime.

A person with this curse is not only unable to judge the directions of north, south, east and west, but also unconsciously takes the path of the wind.

"Fortunately, it's a curse with a statute of limitations, so it seems to be lifted by simply escaping from this stage."

"I see. So two days… um? Wait a minute."

It's strange when you think about it.

Killer King must have been the only one who was cursed?

"Don’t you have a younger sibling? Your younger sister should take the lead."

At my words, Killer King's sister made a startled face.

Killer King looked at her blankly and said.

"Yerin is usually long."

Killer King's younger sister slept on Killer King's side as hard as she could.

Killer King, who frowned slightly, said with a sinister smile.

"Anyway, I have a favor to ask of you."

"A favor?"

"Take us to the central research building. Then I'll spare your life."

Killer King was once again kicked by his sister.

---

It was fortunate to meet the Killer King siblings on this stage.

Killer King is a bit strange, but he was a reliable ally on the same side.

"I think we'd better start right away."

"So far, since the curse effect is also bothering me, I think it would be better to move quickly, even to arrive a minute earlier."

I said while drawing a simple map on the floor.

"I know the location of the research building."

"Jung Heewon hasn't woken up yet."

It was definitely dangerous to carry Jung Heewon on his back. But there wasn't much time given.

"She'll wake up soon. I'm gone and I'll move."

"I don't think there's any ulterior motive. Being tricked by you once is enough."

Come to think of it, the last place I met this brother and sister was inside the Dark Edge.

"You gave us a 'Random Item Box' that had lost its effect at that time."

I answered honestly.

"It was."

"Did you use the box?"

I shook my head.

Of course, I thought he would use [Lie Detection], but I didn't hear the message.

After thinking for a while, Killer King asked.

"Why did you leave the note?"

At the time, I jotted down some useful information in the box I gave them.

If it's Killer King, you've probably got quite a few hidden pieces that are good from that note by now.

"You really don't know?"

Killer King glared at me for a moment, then turned his head away with a face that seemed to have hurt his pride.

"No. I think I know."

It seemed to be so.

If Killer King is curious, he is the type to find out on his own. Because he is such a person, he has read ORV 99.8 times. Ordinarily, I would have read a collection of ORV readings compiled by others.

"By the way, it's difficult to leave now."

The roar of the earth dragons could be heard intermittently. Killer King continued,

"I don't know what you did, but the monsters are going crazy right now because of you."

I remembered the Misreading Association constellations that hindered me.

The 'Plague-Bringing Rat' exited after being hit by a probabilistic aftermath, but one more constellation remained.

The Snake That Cut Off Its Tail.

Perhaps he is the culprit behind this situation.

Judging from the fact that there is no particular setting that comes to mind, it must be a nameless constellation.

Now that nameless constellation was a huge obstacle.

"There are two of them. I saw earlier that they are good at catching level 7 earth dragons."

"It was a surprise attack, so it was easy to catch. If we fight head-on, it will take us longer. And…"

[All paper rolls on the stage are affected by the 'Black Moon' effect.]

Killer King continued his words while glaring at the moon in the sky.

Since that moon rose, the power of the Earth Dragons has been getting stronger.

"If I meet the 7th grade dragon again now, even if I ambushed it, it won’t be easy."

"Fortunately, that 'black moon' has a fixed duration."

[The 'Black Moon' effect lasts for a total of 8 hours.]

It was clear what Killer King meant.

Even when I thought with common sense, it's right to wait here. After Jung Heewon wakes up, it'll be safe to move after the effect of the 'Black Moon' is over.

「That way, I won't lose anyone anymore.」

I already lost Jung Jaewoo because of my misjudgment. If I make a mistake here, other readers… Killer King or Killer King's younger sister may die.

"I still have to go."

I know it's not a realistic judgment. However, it is an impossible world to think realistically.

Because where we are is fiction.

「You have to think of it as novelistic in fiction.」

Guilt can't keep you from doing important things.

Jung Jaewoo is dead.

But he will be a little overseer and will be alive. Maybe other readers will too.

They didn't die.

And if he's not dead, there's a way to bring him back somehow.

I had to believe that now.

This was such a "story," and I had to think of the next development in such a nonsensical world.

「To prevent the planned destruction and pioneer a new story.」

Will I be able to reach the right ending?

"Yoo Joonghyuk may die."

Killer King paused for a moment before asking again.

"Is it true?"

I nodded.

Killer King did not use [Lie Detection]. Instead he looked at his sister.

"Yerin."

The sister quietly shrugged her shoulders, as if to do whatever he wanted. Killer King's troubles were not long.

"I'm going to the research building."

---

We made our way through the broad-leaved forest and headed straight to the central research building.

We often encountered an 8th grade earth dragon raptor, and even more rarely a 7th grade earth dragon, Tyranno.

It took some time, but we steadily moved forward.

The direction was not wrong. According to my thoughts, the research center was definitely over here.

Killer King followed me without a word. He sometimes pruned branches in advance to be considerate of his sister, or warned her to watch her feet.

To be honest. It was a bit incomprehensible to me.

Killer King heard only one word that Yoo Joonghyuk could die, and he was taking the risk with me.

How could that be?

"I have a question."

I asked Killer King, who broke off the protruding branches.

"Why is the name 'Seven Apostles'? At least in ORV, 'apostle' is not used in a very good sense."

In the entire novel, the “apostles” did not read the revelation to the end, but it was a word precisely referring to their executives.

Killer King glared at me for a moment as if asking me all that.

I thought I could hear a sound, and then the leaves swayed one by one.

The rain that had stopped for a while started to fall again.

Could it be because of the sound of rain?

"We are."

I didn't immediately understand what he said.

"I haven't read the story to the end yet."

Understanding came a little late.

I didn't even think of it. I thought it was the community name of readers who simply borrowed the name “Apostle,” but it wasn't.

「The “7 Apostles” was a group of people who believed that the “Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint” was not over yet.」

Since the novel was not over, they were defectors.

"That's why it's an apostle."

Because they are involuntary defectors, they call themselves “apostles.”

"But the story…"

It’s finished.

The moment I was about to say that, something blocked my mouth.

There were countless thoughts running through my head.

The reason I and the readers came to this world now. And an anecdote from Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint that is being serialized on my cell phone as it pleases.

In an instant, goosebumps went down my forearms.

Perhaps, the reason why this world has no choice but to exist is…

"Why are you asking that all of a sudden? Do you want to become an apostle too?"

Killer King was looking at me and asking.

"Even if I wanted to become it, I couldn’t accept it."

"Uh… Why?"

Then Killer King frowned his thick eyebrows and said.

"You act like a guy who knows the end all by himself."

Without realizing it, I burst out laughing.

But Killer King's expression was serious.

"You knew a hidden piece that I didn't know about."

"That…"

"If it's special like now, you’ll smile with a strange expression."

"It's just because I have narrow eyes."

Killer King, ignoring my words, concluded his words by looking at my wounded shoulder.

"In addition to being used to pain. Do you have a [Fourth Wall]?"

I didn't know what to say.

For a moment, such a temptation arose.

Maybe it would be okay to tell him that I am the writer.

But soon I got a thought.

「What's the use of saying that now?」

Now that I am calling myself a writer, I am not responsible for anything about this story.

Maybe my expression was strange, Killer King added with a light smile.

"Don't take it seriously. It's just that I don't like you acting like Kim Dokja."

The building of the central research building could be seen in the distance. We had finally come close to our destination.

"I thought for a while that it would be nice."

Killer King's expression, saying that, seemed somehow lonely.

I thought for a moment about the other readers in the lobby of the theater. Maybe they're accepting the truth of the world by now, too.

「There is no Kim Dokja in this world.」

They read Kim Dokja's story, and were curious about Kim Dokja's story, but they were summoned to this world without Kim Dokja.

Then, for whom does this story exist?

"Get ready soon."

The younger sister of Killer King and Killer King stopped walking.

We all know that the real danger starts now.

Killer King said.

"As you may know, if it was as it should be, the ending conditions should have been met when we hunted the 7th-level Earth Dragon."

It was as Killer King said.

In the main part of the book, the ending message appeared at the moment of hunting “Tyranno,” but now it wasn’t the case.

"It must mean the ending of this movie is not like that."

Coo coo coo.

Right in front of the road leading to the central research building, something was waiting.

[The owner of the theater is looking forward to the ending you will make.]

A cry rang low as if scratching the ground. The ground around us began to shake violently.

The expression of Killer King and Killer King's younger sister hardened. Looking at the faces of the two people with a faint fear spreading, I felt an inexplicable sense of excitement.

Is this how I feel because I am a writer?

There is a guy stronger than 7th grade.

Or is it because I, too, am a first-time reader of this story?

[Grade 6 Earth Dragon, 'Cretaceous owner', roars!]

I thought maybe this theater might have the answer.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 607 Episode 11 Artwork (2)

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"Run."

With Killer King's signal, we ran in the rain.

"Five raptors ahead."

At my signal, Killer King's younger sister, Literature Girl 64 stepped forward.

[White and Blue Steel entwined in the claws of both hands, accelerating in an instant, she snapped the necks of the five raptors like millets.]

"A 7th grade ahead!"

[A 7th grade earth dragon, ‘Tyrannosaurus Rex’, has appeared!]

Grade 7 Earth Dragon, Tyrannosaurus Rex.

The one who got stronger by receiving the power of the black moon knocked down all the hardwoods in front.

It rushed this way.

The literary girl didn't back down and ran to the front of Tyranno.

[Incarnation, 'Lee Seyeon', activates the skill 'Battle Action Mode'!]

Lee Seyeon. It was the name of the person possessed by Literature Girl 64.

Since I don't remember her name, this must be an ordinary extra.

The moment the T-Rex's paw fell on Literature Girl 64's head, she shouted.

"Brother, now!"

"I get it."

[Incarnation, 'Kang Ilhun', has spent 300 coins.]

[Incarnation, 'Kang Ilhun', has taken over the 'Command Controller'.]

A small controller appeared in Killer King's hand. As he entered the command in a flamboyant manner, a bright red aura exploded from Literature Girl 64's entire body.

Using her explosive power, she approached Tyranno's hind legs, and she stretched out her fist, which was raised strongly.

Bang!

With a roar, Tyranno's ankles staggered.

3 consecutive hits.

The enraged Tyranno cried out and swung its huge tail.

His sister exclaimed.

"Parring!"

"I get it."

When Killer King operated the controller, Literature Girl 64 crossed her arms and radiated magical energy at just the right time.

Tyranno's tail bounced off as if it had hit an invisible barrier.

It was a truly phenomenal level of connection.

I never thought I'd see that skill that only applies in games being actually reproduced.

[You have activated 4 Intermediate Commands in a row!]

[Penalties for 'Battle Action Mode' are activated!]

[Command input will be suspended for 30 seconds.]

"Yerin!"

"Don't worry."

The Tyranno, who had trodden its foot, stamped it into the ground at random. Literature Girl 64 jumped up the tree.

It wasn't a clean move like before, but an appropriate maneuver using innate physicality.

As the trees in the area were to be uprooted, Literature Girl 64, guessing, went around Tyranno.

"It's okay. Now!"

[The penalty for 'Battle Action Mode' is lifted!]

LiteraryGirl64, who caught the timing, got on the Tyranno's tail and started to run.

A strange smile crept onto Killer King's mouth as he operated the controller.

"Vision yes. Dark Spinning Breaker."

Literature girl 64's claw spinning like a top in the air is a dark red color.

She ripped out both of Tyrannosaurus' eyes as it turned back, then thrust the claw through the center of its skull.

With a thump, Tyranno's floor bones shattered and its blood spurted out.

[Successfully activated advanced command!]

[The battle action mode is canceled.]

[General Review: 91 points for linkage! Are you aspiring to be a pro gamer?]

The aura disappeared from Literature Girl 64's body.

With a sigh, she trudged down from Tyranno's gigantic body. A slight tiredness was felt in her gait.

"What is the linkage score?"

"91 points. Too bad."

"It's better than before."

"I still have enough coins left to play a few more times."

"What is that?"

"What do you mean?"

"You gave my technique a strange name."

"I don't remember."

Through that one fight, I got to know the fighting styles of the two.

[Battle Action Mode is literally a skill that allows you to manipulate your strengthened body as if you were playing a fighting action game.]

When LiteraryGirl64 activates her skill and passes the controller to Killer King, Killer King activates her skill by inputting a command.

It was a simple, but never easy connection.

A combat method that creates explosive synergies in an instant, with one person focusing on strengthening the body and the other focusing only on the movement of the body.

It was a battle method that was possible because they were two people who fully believed in each other.

Killer King said, perhaps conscious of my gaze.

"You seem surprised by the control of this body."

"Your sister is really amazing."

"If you've seen it to your heart's content, take out the secret weapon you've been hiding."

We continued running through the forest.

There was less than a hundred meters to the research building.

Oh oh oh!

Perhaps because of the influence of the black moon, the speed of the monsters chasing us is getting faster.

There were at least twenty hordes of raptors approaching from either side. There were over ten guys blocking the front.

The Killer King frowned and said.

"Yerin, what is the cooldown time?"

"There are still three minutes left."

Apparently, there is a cooldown for [Battle Action Mode].

I said, speeding up my steps.

"I'll try it this time."

I took a deep breath

[Incite with the “last dragon of the Apocalypse” earlier failed.]

Maybe it's because I'm not good enough. So, is the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon possible? I don't know.

Anyway, “Tyranno” was a success.

Then.

"I am."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.6', is activated!]

"I am the Snake That Cut Off Its Tail."

Tsutsutsutsutsutsutsu!

As expected, there seems to be a penalty for [Inciting] as someone with a higher rank than me. Pain surged through the blood vessels throughout my body, as if electricity were flowing instead of blood, and my consciousness flickered for a moment.

[The constellation, 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail', looks at you with astonished eyes.]

Still, it was probably because his level was low, and I was able to withstand this level of aftermath.

I swallowed the rising blood. I thought I could say at least one word.

"Go away!"

All the raptors in front of me were frightened by my cry and ran away.

['Incite', is canceled.]

My whole body trembled as if I had been electrocuted with the sound of Tsutsutsutsu and Killer King supported me as I stumbled and vomited.

"I didn’t know [Incite] could be used like this."

"Cheon Inho is more of a fraud than I thought."

We jumped right into the central research building. Fortunately, the 6th-level Earth Dragon hadn't moved yet, but there was a problem.

Upon entering, the central research building was divided into A and B.

"We need to secure an ampoule. You know."

I nodded.

The rewards you can get from this movie are various 'ability ampoules'.

Killer King moved to building B and said to us.

"You go to Building A with Yerin. I'll be in charge of Building B."

"Will you be okay by yourself?"

"Don’t care."

Maybe because I'm carrying Jeong Heewon on my back, a proper battle is impossible.

This time, I didn't hesitate to be considerate. I couldn't afford to think about that.

I searched Building A with Literature Girl 64, and found the place I was looking for within a few minutes.

[Embryology Lab.]

We immediately opened the door and entered.

Looking at the flasks and ampoules scattered throughout the laboratory, it seemed that we had come to the right place.

In a transparent incubator, a baby dinosaur was seen as an embryo.

While I was looking at the scene inadvertently, Literature Girl 64 approached me.

"They'll never be born."

Words that I don't know whether they're questions or self-talk.

I answered at random.

"I guess so."

This hidden scenario is just a virtual stage. The moment the movie ends, everything will disappear. The same would be true for these embryonic dinosaurs.

Literature Girl 64 said in a nonchalant voice.

"Maybe it's better not to be born."

Looking back at her absentmindedly, LiteraryGirl64 lowered her head as if avoiding my gaze.

According to my recollection, she had never read the entire book. It was only said that her brother, Killer King, had told her over and over again.

How does she feel about being drawn into this world?

"Is this it?"

"Yes, that's right."

When reading, we quickly found the ability ampoules that appeared in the main story.

Comprehensive stat ampoules that increase strength, stamina, sensitivity, and horsepower, respectively.

The total number of ampoules found was twenty-four.

We split the ability ampoules in half each. I decided to take the special ampoule I found additionally.

Tyrant T-Rex's DNA Ampoule.

An item that increases all stats by 10 for 30 minutes when consumed.

Considering the last floor of the theater dungeon, this ampoule was a must.

Koo-goo-goo-goo!

The whole building shook precariously as if it had been hit by an artillery shell.

"Let’s go straight to the roof."

Outside the window, I saw a huge earth dragon getting up.

The research buildings are connected to each other

If he has heard the commotion, the Killer King is probably coming up on the roof.

The 6th-grade Ji Yong-jong, the master of the Cretaceous period, roars!

[All living things in the area fall into 'predation fear'!]

The roar that roared through the entire building made me feel like my spine froze for an instant.

I quickly activated the skill.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.6', is activated.]

"There is no need to be afraid."

LiteraryGirl64, who had been frozen for a while, came back to her senses and climbed the stairs.

After a roar, the Earth Dragon swung its front paws around as if searching for its prey. All the windows in Building B were destroyed, and the building began to collapse from

the corner. It was the same research building where Killer King entered.

Literature Girl 64 opened her mouth.

"My brother is strong."

I know. Killer King is clearly an excellent incarnation.

However, his areas of excellence were resourcefulness and fighting, not overall ability or physical abilities.

Above all, the character he possessed was Kang Ilhun, the vice president of the Dongdaemun Group.

No matter how much Jophiel acquired as a sponsor, the probability of surviving that collapse site considering the potential of his incarnation is-

"You are late."

The roof door burst open, revealing Killer King.

"Ampoules?"

"I got it."

When his sister answered, Killer King nodded.

"Leave right away."

The Earth Dragon, who had spotted us, was gathering his breath towards us.

[The owner of the 6th level Jiryonggun, the Cretaceous, prepares the Cretaceous Silk!]

It seems to use something similar to a breath that is a 6th grade earth dragon.

Fortunately, an escape helicopter had arrived on the roof of the research building.

"Get on!"

After Literature Girl 64 got on first, she accepted Jung Heewon, who was away from me. Jung Heewon seemed to take quite a while to wake up. As it was, there was no problem in escaping.

However.

[This helicopter is limited to 3 people.]

[A new helicopter will be created in 10 minutes.]

The noise of the helicopters deafened my ears.

I could see Literature Girl 64 shouting something.

There was no way this was it.

In the main story, it was clear that four people could board the helicopter.

[The 'Theater Owner' is satisfied with the ending condition change.]

The scenario has changed.

Maybe it's because the maximum number of people in a “team” is three.

Only up to three people can escape at once.

[The constellation, 'Snake Cutting off its Tail', protests!]

[The constellation, 'Snake Cutting off its Tail', claims an end to annihilation.]

[The 'Theater Owner' ignores the constellation's claim.]

[The 'Theater Owner' wonders who the final victim will be.]

I looked back at Killer King. He happened to be talking to his sister.

「If it’s these two.」

If Jung Heewon were added to the teamwork the two showed, wouldn't it be possible to prevent a showdown on the rooftop?

I took a step back from my blood and thought.

Ahhh, the chopper is coming again. You only need to buy 10 minutes while running away somehow. If I use [Incite] to the maximum–

"You ride it."

Turning around, Killer King was talking with his back turned.

Is it a hallucination created by an urgent situation?

It felt as if Yoo Joonghyuk was standing there.

I shook my head and stood next to him.

"I'll stay. You ride there."

The master of the Cretaceous Period's lungs swelled greatly. Its breath will pour out soon.

I'm ready to use [Incite].

Even if I overdo it, let's become the Snake That Cut Off Its Tail one more time. Then I might be able to pick up the direction of its breath a little bit.

"It's a 6th-level earth dragon. It's not an opponent you can do anything about with [incite].

"You have to do that to know."

"I know even if I don't try. I've read the Revelation 100 times."

"Wasn't it 99.8 times?"

"I reread what I knew in my head."

You don’t usually say you've read that?

Killer King asked without giving me a chance to tackle.

"How many times have you read it?"

"I–"

“You must have read it over 100 times. I can tell. But."

After saying that, Killer King put on the black half-glove he took out from his chest.

"I read it more diligently."

As he took a step forward, an unusual spark flew from his body.

[The constellation, 'Commander of the Red Cosmos', praises the courage of his incarnation.]

[The constellation, 'Commander of the Red Cosmos', bestows blessings on his incarnation.]

"I read it ten times, a hundred times harder than you."

There was no agitation in Killer King. Even so, at that moment. For some reason, I felt persuaded by Killer King’s words.

With those words, Killer King ran towards the “Owner of the Cretaceous Period.”

In an instant, I remembered ORV.

His sponsor is “Commander of the Red Cosmos,” Jophiel.

I remembered the way Jophiel fought in the 1863rd round.

「The whole sky howled in agony. At first glance, it was red fog, but if you look closely, each one was a large army of small soldiers. Unit 503 of <Eden> dyed the sky red.」

A bloody elite soldier who follows the “Commander of the Red Cosmos.”

The red mist that was now dwelling all over Killer King was neither as thick nor as wide as the one in the 1863rd round.

Just enough fog to barely protect one person.

Quadddeed!

The breath of the dinosaur from the Cretaceous period colliding with the red mist was dispersing.

"Get on! We don’t have time!"

When I turned around, Killer King's sister was holding me by the sleeve.

Without hesitating any longer, I boarded the helicopter.

The helicopter slowly rose from the ground. Killer King's appearance quickly began to recede.

The furious Earth Dragon raced towards Killer King. Unfortunately, Killer King's red fog had already disappeared. The monster's paws lightly grabbed Killer King's helplessly exposed body.

As I was about to stand up from my seat, Killer King's sister grabbed me.

"My brother is strong."

Two people had faith. The faith of a person who has read a certain novel a hundred times, and the faith of a person who has spent that time together.

「A reader who has read a story a hundred times might be able to find even the lost sentences of the writer who wrote the story.」

Looking closely, the item held in Killer King's right hand emitted a faint light.

I immediately realized what the item was.

「Petrified Dongja.」

Killer King safely got one of the hidden pieces that I wrote down on a note in the box.

「A disposable item that becomes “stone statue” for 4 hours after use.」

[Stone Statue status is not easily canceled unless it is hit by at least a constellation level being.]

If it was that item, it would surely be able to survive an attack from a 6th-level earth dragon.

I could see Killer King's body hardening into solid stone.

['Ending credit' reached.]

[Actors: Cheon Inho, Lee Seyeon, Jung Heewon.]

[You obtained 500 coins each as an appearance fee.]

The 2nd Apostle of the 7 Apostles, Killer King.

The man who still believed that this story was not over was looking up.

Waving his stiff hand, he seemed to be signaling something.

I couldn't figure out what he meant, but his sister listened to him.

"I’m curious about the next part."

Those were his words.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 608 Episode 11 Artwork (3)

---

I got a new colleague.

['Lee Seyeon' has entered your team.]

ID: Literature Girl 64.

Killer King's younger sister, the fighting genius.

A temporary alliance was established to save Killer King.

[The starter has been recruited into the team.]

[An additional 500 coins are acquired.]

After assessing the current situation as calmly as possible, I opened my mouth.

"The [gargoyle] status ailment will last for four hours inside the stage. Time flows faster outside, so we have to move with the idea of finishing the dungeon in at least two hours."

Of course, there was a possibility that a miracle would happen and Killer King could hunt a 6th-class land dragon or escape on his own, but such a possibility was ruled out.

Realistically, the surest way to save Killer King is to clear the dungeon in the shortest amount of time and end the screening of the movie.

Literature Girl 64 asked.

"Is Yoo Joonghyuk upstairs?"

"Maybe."

"I wonder if Yoo Joonghyuk could clear the dungeon."

I felt like I sensed something in Literature Girl's way of talking about it.

"Is there a problem?"

I nodded.

Literature Girl 64 seemed to think for a moment about what the problem was.

She could just ask, but at times like this, the way the siblings acted was similar.

[Cleared the stage with adjusted difficulty!]

[You get 3,000 coins as an additional reward!]

[Additional dice obtained!]

[Additional dice obtained!]

Perhaps it was because we had cleared a fairly difficult movie, and we received up to 3,000 coins for five reward dice.

"I'll roll the dice first."

As I watched the dice spinning in the air, I thought of Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi.

How far have these two come?

Are they hurt?

Is Lee Jihye playing her role?

Just as Literature Girl 64 believes in Killer King, I wish I had strong faith. I want to believe that they will be safe.

[The eye of the die is 5.]

[Go up the stairs 5 steps.]

[You've reached the 3rd floor!]

[The eye of the die is 5.]

[Go up the stairs 5 steps.]

The value of the rolling dice was not bad.

We covered 24 steps in an instant.

And.

[You have entered the reward room on the 5th floor.]

Finally, the reward room.

The moment I was about to step out, Literature Girl 64 stopped me.

The reason was immediately clear.

A decapitated corpse was visible beneath a cabinet lined with reward items.

The hairs on my forearm stood out.

Literature Girl 64 looked around and said.

"I don't think there is anyone else."

We slowly approached and checked the body. A few steps away from the corpse's body, the man's head was rolling.

I said, suppressing the reflexive feeling of vomiting.

"This is the member of the Misreading Association. He was the one who claimed to be a writer."

The sharp cut on his neck was terrifying. Even so, he was a guy who had good luck, but he was killed in an instant.

If he's dead here, it must mean that someone has already gone upstairs.

There was no time.

"Get the reward first."

We each scattered and checked the items we wanted to collect as rewards.

[Reward items are limited to 2 per person.]

I chose a sword and combat uniform for her to use instead of Jung Heewon.

[Mikazuki Munechika – Replica: Class A sword.]

The first thing I chose was the sword she used in the main story. In addition, I picked out a combat uniform that seemed useful to her.

[Impossible Mission – Replica: Class A Armor.]

If this is enough, I won't have to worry about Jung Heewon's equipment for the time being. By the way, seeing that she still hadn't woken up, the aftereffects of [Incite] seemed to last quite a while.

I'll have to be careful when using it in the future.

After choosing Jung Heewon's equipment, I looked at the equipment I could use.

I had two pieces of equipment I could take with me, but one wasn't mine. It was because I had to keep his promise with the 7th apostle Ye Hyunwoo.

Let's see.

I wonder if I looked around for about 30 seconds like that. I found the item in question.

[Shingijeon Replica: A-class artillery.]

Wow, this is real.

Description: A speaker (X) made in the Joseon Dynasty, a kind of multi-launch rocket weapon.

It can fire 15 shots at a time, up to 100 shots in a row.

> The passive skill [Heavy Firepower] is built-in, greatly amplifying the ranged artillery fire ability of allies within 10 square meters when used.

Just looking at the description, I can understand why Ye Hyunwoo wanted this item. If you link the turrets led by Gong Pildu, there will definitely be tremendous synergies.

['Shingijeon Replica' is selected.]

[This item has a built-in 'reduced transformation' function.]

I was wondering how to take this, but fortunately it was an item that could be reduced and transformed.

I chose the new item and put it in my pocket.

And besides that, I looked for useful items while going around the whole room.

Like the replica version of “Molnir” that Lee Gilyoung used in the main story, or “Hercules' Shield.”

Thought of Almost Anything, who had turned into slime, was excited to see the items lined up.

It was clinging to all over the place.

The mimicry skill of [Thoughts of Almost Everything] increases!

[It learnt a new mimicry form!]

[It learnt a new mimicry form!]

Perhaps it was because its proficiency had risen, but now the conditions for collecting the shape of A-class or lower items were not so difficult.

About 5 minutes after that, I collected most of the weapon shapes in the [Room of Reward].

[‘Thoughts of Almost Everything’ is satisfied with its prey of forms.]

Although there were no imitations of S-class or higher, if I collected this much, there would not be a shortage of weapons for a while. I finally chose one protective gear.

Weapons can be summoned at any time using 'thought', but since protective gear must be worn at the same time, it was impossible to rely on the [Mimicry] function alone.

[External Reinforced Suit - Replica: A-class armor.]

And Kim Dokja also chose this suit.

In the current situation, I thought it wouldn't be bad to choose this.

Looking around, Literature Girl 64 must have had the same thoughts, and she had chosen the female version of the 'exterior strengthening suit'.

After we got ready, we stood in the aisle again going upstairs.

[This is the end of the trip together with Departure Cinema Travel.]

[There is no movement bonus for 'latecomers' from that floor onwards.]

[You are the first to complete the 'Departure Cinema Trip' scenario.]

[You will receive 2,000 coins as a reward.]

Now, it is no longer possible to skip the number of floors using the dice trick.

Instead, there was an advantage that from now on, you could move along the path that the 'first runner' had pierced in advance.

When we actually took the escalator to the sixth floor, we saw movie posters torn to pieces.

How many movies had been completed, the 6th floor was almost in a state of nothing but ruins.

Looking at the traces left here and there, it seemed that more than half of them were the workmanship of Yoo Joonghyuk.

Come to think of it, as soon as he returned, he was the one who killed the 7th grade monster species. I couldn't guess how much stronger he would have become now.

Can I really change the ending of this story just because I go up?

I lost my confidence a bit, but I wasn't depressed.

We got through the 6th floor without encountering any movies.

If we're lucky, we might be able to get to the roof as it is. Hurry up.

A little faster. A little bit more–

"Ah."

Was it too hasty?

[You have been hit by the projection beam.]

[The screening of that floor begins.]

I was shocked to hear the message.

Where?

It's all just torn movie posters?

"It's under your feet."

It was torn, but the poster was underfoot.

[The movie poster is broken]

[Only part of the film is reproduced.]

With the feeling of the floor sinking, we were sucked into pitch black darkness. And when we woke up, we were locked in a room with white walls on six sides.

---

rlaehrwk99 : Isn't that movie cube?

rlaehrwk124: How old is 99?

---

[The film is not in perfect condition.]

[You can escape from the movie when you complete certain conditions.]

Fortunately, we didn't come into the whole movie.

When I hit the inner wall several times with a white-blue steel machine, Literature Girl 64 said, "You can't pierce it by force."

I agreed with her.

"I know roughly what movie it is."

Cube controlled room, and a possible escape when the condition is fulfilled.

It was a film that the creators could not have known.

The problem is the “escape condition.”

Judging from the experience so far, there was a possibility that the owner of the theater did something annoying this time too.

However.

[The constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', is curious about your story.]

[The constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', presents conditions for escape from the room to the Theater Owner.]

Uriel?

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier is curious about your story.]

[A constellation that has not yet revealed a modifier presents the Room’s Escape Condition.]

In addition, the constellations that did not reveal their modifiers?

[The Theater Owner accepts the constellations' offer.]

I wanted to have a premonition of something disturbing, but the escape conditions were soon revealed.

> Escape condition: Talk in the room for 30 minutes.

A clock appeared in the air.

[30:00.]

I looked up at the watch blankly and thought.

Really? Are these all the conditions?

Additional narratives followed.

> However, if silence lasts for more than 30 seconds, all personnel in the room will die.

I got goosebumps.

There are three people in the room right now.

Me, Jung Heewon, and Literature Girl 64.

Since Jung Heewon passed out, it meant that I had to talk with Literature Girl 64 for 30 minutes.

It wasn't an atrocious condition, but I thought it wouldn't be easy.

I'm not the type to be that good at conversations, and neither is that-

"Even if there are only some of them."

"Yes?"

"Can this be called a movie?"

Did you naturally bring up the topic first?

I was slightly moved by her consideration and replied with nothing.

"These days, the short form is the trend. Wouldn’t <Star Stream> also follow the trend?"

"What is the short form?"

"So, you cut or summarized the highlights of the video, so to speak-"

"Highlight."

Literature girl 64 thought hard and added.

"Anything with only highlights, it doesn't even have an e-light."

"Um... I agree."

Even though I agreed, I felt strangely stabbed by my conscience.

In fact, I thought the writing I was writing was similar.

Composing a compact plot with minimal build-up, and pushing the highlights every time.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', is yawning as if bored.]

In a world where everything is a highlight, I have been writing with only highlights in mind. Is that why?

"Uh, can I call you Yerin too? Or..."

No matter how much I think about it, this moment, which is not a highlight, felt a little fresh.

"Yerin is my real name."

"Then...."

"Call me whatever you like."

"Yes."

“By the way, do you like novels?”

"Ah yes."

“Do you like this novel too?”

If this is a novel, then it must be referring to ORV. Can a novelist like the novels he wrote? Any novelist would do that.

Then what about me?

"My brother likes this novel."

"What about you, Yerin-ssi?"

Literature Girl 64 was silent for a moment.

[You must continue the conversation within 15 seconds.]

She wondered if she should turn to another topic, but she answered.

"I've never read it myself."

"Oh."

"My brother always read to me."

I had guessed her general circumstances.

Several clues came together naturally in my head.

Read ORV more than 10 times.

The habit of always wearing sunglasses.

The image of young siblings confronting RepresentativeKimDokja in the theater.

The figure of the girl holding the sleeves behind the boy naturally overlapped over Literature Girl 64's face.

"In real life, I'm blind."

This time it was a self-indulgence for me to be silent.

[You must continue the conversation within 10 seconds.]

Even though I knew that I would die if I didn't speak up within 10 seconds, I couldn't easily come up with the next words.

Fortunately, Literature Girl 64 continued.

"I am fine now."

"Okay."

"This is how the world my brother always talked about looks like."

"What do you think of this novel?"

Literature Girl 64, who hesitated for a moment and chose her words, opened her mouth.

"I think it’s a novel that lacks perfection."

I was caught off guard and hit to the bone.

"I felt that way the whole time I was listening to it. The characters are rather flat, and the story seems contrived."

"There is so much emotion in the directing. The further you go, the more monotonous the pattern of development is."

Perhaps it was an act, there was a strange rebuke in her voice. She seemed to be talking faster than before.

Are you actually someone who hates reading ORV?

It could be.

It is not strange that there are various readers in the world.

"Because web novels are serialized daily. I understand. But give me a hole to breathe."

I asked with a bitter smile.

"Do you often read web novels?"

"I sometimes ask my brother to read it to me, but it’s not my favorite genre."

"Which genre do you like? Or even a favorite writer..."

Her ID is Literature Girl 64.

If it wasn't an ID given by Killer King, she'd probably like novels too.

As if she had waited, she opened her mouth.

"Raymond Carver."

"…?"

“There is Haruki Murakami, Han River, William Faulkner, John Steinbeck...."

It seems that she has similar reading tastes to someone I know.

Literature Girl 64 nodded, probably reading my thoughts.

"I think Yoo Sangah's taste in reading is excellent."

"Oh."

I couldn't tell if it was a joke or not, so I laughed out loud.

Literature Girl 64 didn't laugh.

I got a little nervous and asked the question again.

“What is your favorite work?"

Anyway, I thought it was good.

A room where you have to talk for the next 30 minutes to escape.

It was a pleasure to have a topic to talk about after a long time. When it comes to novels, I have the confidence to talk about it for an hour or two. That was until I heard her next words.

"I like 『The Origin of Memory』."

For a moment, I thought maybe I had heard something wrong.

What kind of novel do you like?

"That… You're talking about a Korean artist's work, right?"

"Yes. You know."

I couldn't not know.

"I know, but do you really like the work?"

"Yes."

Because this novel…

"It is my favorite work."

It's mine. It was the debut work of “Lee Hakhyun.”

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 609 Episode 11 Artwork (4)

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It was at the age of twenty-three that I made my debut in the literary world.

「Announcement of the winners of the 24th Rookie of the Year Award. “The Origin of Memory.” Writer Lee Hakhyun.」

It wasn't because I had some great talent that I made my debut early.

Honestly, at that age, how much did a young man know and write?

A sentence like a half-dried squid that awkwardly mimics an established writer.

There were writers who valued such things highly, and that year, I was the only one who was fortunate enough to be evaluated.

My luck ended there, and after that I was quickly forgotten by the world.

"That's how he walked towards his origins. I like that sentence."

I thought it was forgotten.

Until this person showed up.

"I also liked the works after that. [Origin of Faith], [Origin of Falsehood] ...The Origins Trilogy."

"How do you know these novels which are not well known?"

Exactly three.

Someone who has read all the stories I wrote.

It was so surprising that such a reader existed in the world.

"There were always out-of-season literary magazines among the books donated to the nursery school."

Nursery school.

At that word that came out naturally, I secretly inhaled.

"I asked my brother to read any novel in the library, and the first novel I heard was the one published in a literary magazine."

"I see."

"Have you read that novel?"

I nodded and replied.

"It's a story in which the protagonist lies about his childhood."

"That's the highlight."

"Because I can't tell you everything."

If I talked about it all here, all the constellations listening to it would fall asleep.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', snores, asking what the hell you are talking about.]

[A Constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier is disciplined to listen to the story.]

Of course, there are constellations with maniac tastes.

After thinking about it for a while, I added a bit of flesh to the story for the maniac constellations.

"[Origin of Memories] is the story of a writer who fabricates his 'childhood' to sell books and give lectures. Can this be an explanation?"

It was the first time I was talking about my debut work to other people, so I felt a bit strange.

Literature Girl 64 said as if she was working hard.

"Tell me about the rest."

I don't know why you're asking me to tell you about a story you've already read, but I continued the story for now.

"Eventually, the main character's fraud is exposed to his alumni and exposed on the Internet."

"That's right. I found the main character's reaction interesting in that part. No one is harmed because I had a past like that. Everyone has the right to have their own story."

I replied in admiration.

"You remember the lines exactly."

"It was also interesting that the main character’s lie at the end was actually true."

"I remember that part was handled a little vaguely."

"It is not ambiguous. It turns out that the alumni who exposed the main character on the Internet actually mistook the main character for an odd person. Since only the main character remembers the story that no one remembers, pray for the origin of memory and the only person who deserves it is the main character."

As I listened to her clear impressions, I remembered the days when I had been writing that novel for a long time.

A time when I was always empty somewhere, wondering where I came from and what I exist for.

There was a time when I wrote sentences to know that.

"After that, the basic tone of the works was similar. They always dealt with the story of 'false' or 'origin', and that was interesting. It would have been nice if the writer continued to write.

I kept writing.

Literature Girl 64 who had been thinking about something for a while continued.

"I read all the webnovels novels written by that writer."

“A webnovel?”

"My brother was very bothered to read it to me… Later, he also read hard."

"That. A web novel."

"The Orc Philosopher."

The moment the title of my first failed webnovel flowed out of her mouth, I wondered if all of this was an illusion created by my paranoia.

"Now that I think about it, I think the author wrote it without knowing what a webnovel was."

There can be no hallucination that makes such an accurate assessment.

"『Infinite Prisoner』. This metaphor was a bit simplistic, but still…"

It felt like someone was cutting my neck and attaching it over and over again.

"The Magician of the Undying World. I trained hard in anticipation that the world's aspirations would come, but no matter how long I waited, the world would not perish, so I became a wizard who went to destroy the world myself… "

"…"

"And again…"

Literature Girl continued to appreciate the novels I wrote.

Sometimes I stop talking and choose my words

『Method Master』, 『System Breaker』…

I wonder if Kim Dokja felt this way after revealing his secret taste to his colleagues.

"How to Become a Star Writer…"

When even the title, which I had momentarily erased from my memory, popped up, I almost fainted.

"There was a part that felt like an experience story, but I liked it. I knew it would get a license in the end."

Surprisingly, most of my previous works were given good reviews.

Except for one piece.

"Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint... wasn't it?"

Why did I ask such a question?

I do not know.

Maybe I've been waiting for the moment to ask someone this question all along.

"Rather than not."

Literature Girl 64 chose her words seriously for about 20 seconds and continued.

"The novel didn't seem like it was written by the author."

I listened to her with my mouth closed.

"In all other works, I felt the author vividly, but only in that work, I felt like the author was just a spectator of the story."

In one moment, too many thoughts rushed in and out.

Only then did I realize that I had been preparing for this moment all along.

「As expected, this story is not written by me.」

It's just what I've been waiting for.

To hear the fact that I already knew from someone else's mouth.

I asked, hiding my discouragement.

"You must have been disappointed."

"I am not disappointed."

Literature Girl 64 said without any change in expression.

"It's just that my brother liked that story better, and I liked the other stories written by the author better. That's all."

"And then, my brother said that. Maybe the writer possessed this world like us."

Hearing those words spoken carelessly, I was taken aback and laughed nonchalantly.

"Maybe."

"I wish the author were still alive."

The long 30 minutes were already coming to an end. Looking up at the watch in the air, she concluded her words.

"I have to ask when he’s going to write the next story."

Maybe that expression right now is the highlight of this scenario. It's been a while, but I thought so.

---

[Entered the 7th floor]

We continued to climb up the cinema, watching our steps.

An hour passed by while I was going through this and that. The dungeon must be cleared within the remaining hour. Otherwise, Killer King will be in danger.

Judging by the atmosphere, it seemed that the fight on the rooftop hadn't been decided yet. How far had I moved past the torn posters?

We finally arrived at the door to the 8th floor - Sky Garden.

However.

"Uh?"

The exit to the place was blocked.

The exit was covered with pure white crystals, but I quickly realized what it was.

[Steelization.]

It was clearly a trace of [steelization].

Lee Hyunsung himself, or someone who borrowed Lee Hyunsung's skill blocked the door.

Judging by the degree of crystallization, [steelization] is in its very early stage. It was also thin.

Literature Girl 64 activated [White and Blue Steel] and knocked on the door as a test.

Kaga!

Even so, it was [White and Blue Steel], but she could only get a tiny blush.

Even in the early stages, the intensity of [White and Blue Steel] is extraordinary.

"There is a way."

Literature Girl 64 said in a calm voice.

"But I can't do it alone."

I wondered what that might mean. I don't think it will break if you knock it together.

"Are you good at games?"

Ah.

[Incarnation, 'Lee Seyeon', activates the 'Battle Action Mode'!]

Did you mean that?

[Incarnation, 'Lee Seyeon', temporarily transfers the 'Command Controller' to you.]

Soon after, a coin slot appeared in front of me. When I put in 300 coins, a controller with the same shape as Killer King used was implemented in front of me.

['Command Control' is activated.]

I gently put down Jung Heewon, who was not there, and held the controller in my hand.

"I don’t have confidence… Can I do the same as Killer King did?"

Literature Girl 64 shook her head.

"If you're that strong, you'll have to use a special move."

Literature Girl 64 gave me the command of the technique and added.

"My brother also practiced several times, but failed."

I could understand why he failed just by listening to the command. The timing was also difficult, but the command was too complicated.

"Did you memorize it?"

"Roughly."

"Not roughly. If you do it wrong, your qi and blood will be distorted and you will die."

She made something terrifying sound natural.

"Can I practice alone?"

"I’ll give you three minutes."

After saying that, Literature Girl 64 raised her cross-legged position and closed her eyes. She seemed to be concentrating her body's mana.

I sighed lightly and looked down at the controller.

Am I good at games?

I don't know. I think it's about average though. In terms of online game tier... I guess it's about gold.

Yes, I know. Of course it won't be that much.

Killer King had high-level control skills. There is no way I can succeed with a technique that even such Killer King couldn't succeed.

But.

「I know someone who can do that.」

Literature Girl 64 woke up and asked.

"Did you memorize everything?"

"I memorized it."

"Then let's begin."

The command was memorized.

The problem is the timing, and not making mistakes.

Literature Girl 64 took a preliminary action. She could feel the quiet energy gathering in her right fist.

I focused on the flow of the magical power she radiated, and memorized the deadly command.

「From now on, I am.」

I imagined.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.6', is activated!]

A person who is better at games than anyone I know.

「I am pro gamer Yoo Joonghyuk.」

At that moment, in my head, a new world was opened. The world changed like a simulation, and the flow of time slowed down slightly.

[Your imagination is activated to the limit.]

As if peeping into the future, all the variables around me came into view at a glance.

Of course, it's not as good as real pro gamer Yoo Joonghyuk, but am I still good enough to imitate him?

The flow that dwells in her fist, and the place where her fist is headed. And from the point of impact to the release of exploding magical power.

I was able to get a zoom, and I was able to get a flower.

Literature Girl 64's fist moved. Swirling white-blue magic power. Her fist, penetrating space like a flash war, exploded at the center of the door.

I didn't ask for the name of the skill, but I thought I knew what the King might have called it.

「White Blue Fist.」

Obviously, that would be the name.

In the roar, crystals of ironization were seen shattering.

Through the broken door, the scenery of the rooftop was peeped out.

[The special move command has been successfully activated!]

[The battle action mode is canceled.]

[Review: 92 connection points! Are you a pro gamer hiding your powers?]

Along with the message I heard, Literature Girl 64 grabbed my shoulder.

"Wait."

The moment I saw her pale complexion, I knew what was going on.

The technique succeeded, but her spirit and blood were twisted. Maybe it’s because I wasn’t really 'Pro Gamer Yoo Joonghyuk'.

"It's okay if I rest. But from now on, it's hard to help."

She took a deep breath and looked at me.

[Incarnation, ‘Lee Seyeon', has activated the skill 'Vision transfer Lv.1'.]

Vision transmission.

A skill that allows you to learn one S-rank or lower skill from someone else, just once.

"I was originally going to give it to my brother. I think you'd better take it."

[You received the skill from Incarnation: Lee Seyeon.]

"Save my brother."

"Wait a minute. This is–"

I hurriedly grabbed Literature Girl 64. She had already passed out.

I laid her on the ground, then slowly turned toward the door.

Beyond the broken door, I could feel the waves of unusual tales. My limbs were tingling, and my backbone was aching.

As when writing the first sentence on a blank sheet of paper, deep fear and anticipation rushed at the same time.

I knew it instinctively even before '□□' was activated.

「I could die on the other side of that door.」

My fingertips felt warm. I remembered the skills, items, and sentences I had before the warmth disappeared.

「Although knowing the truth, Lee Hakhyun moved forward.」

That was the only sentence I could write now.

I took one big step and entered the roof.

[You have entered the 'Sky Garden' on the 8th floor.]

The eighth floor was exactly the same scenery as described in the main part of the book.

A small dome reminiscent of an opera house surrounded by an opaque dome.

「What I saw as soon as I stepped onto the rooftop covered with green grass was the back of the regressor I had been looking for.」

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Unbeknownst to me, my steps quickened.

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round.

The main character who hunted a 7th-class monster at the beginning and even surpassed a narrative-grade constellation in the previous round.

That Yoo Joonghyuk was stiff like a mannequin.

Yoo Joonghyuk's pupils, as if sunk in a deep abyss, passed out. I realized the moment I saw the bloodless lips.

「Yoo Joonghyuk lost.」

When I put my hand to the tip of his nose, his breath was stuck. No major injuries were seen. It is a injury that he suffered from a mental skill.

Tsutsutsutsu...

Sparks were popping up everywhere.

I looked around the edge of the "sky garden."

As expected, the owner of this "Theater Dungeon" was sitting there.

['Theater Owner Simulation' has appeared.]

The theater's dungeon boss specialized in mental skills.

But something was strange.

Yoo Joonghyuk is weak against mental attacks, but if he came around the 41st round, he wouldn't be weak against the theater's dungeon boss.

When I looked closely, the theater owner sitting on the bench also looked like a broken toy.

Story. Story. Story. Story.

Like an old movie projector, the Theater Owner's mouth rattled.

Looking closely, in the backlight, someone was holding his head.

Their shadow permeated like deeply pressed type.

I completely moved my gaze following the shadow.

A feast of power that oppresses the surroundings.

I didn't have the confidence to face the owner of the shadow.

「Some books are overwhelming before you even open them.」

I bit my lip as hard as I could. I slowly raised my head. I have already come this far. If you don't open the book, the story won't begin. I barely lifted my head amidst the pressure, and there was the first sentence.

"Are you here already?"

Her tone was lofty, as if she had no interest in the story of this world.

"I looked down on it because it was only the 41st round. It’s pretty good."

Through the flickering backlight, there was the face of a person I had imagined for a long time.

「She is the author who wrote all the sentences of this world.」

I called the author's name.

"Han Sooyoung."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 610 Episode 12 □□ (1)

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"Stories are not subject to the rules of time. They just flow towards an empty place."

—Dokkaebi King

---

How is 'Han Sooyoung' here?

Is that person really the Han Sooyoung of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 that I know?

My intuition said yes, but my reason demanded verification.

[This is a target that you cannot use 'List of Reader Comments' on.]

['Character List' is unavailable.]

Target unavailable.

"Really, are you Han Sooyoung?"

I've never had such a message pop up before.

「I didn't expect it.」

When I found out that this world was the 41st turn not in the original work.

After seeing kkomas Kim Dokja at the theater.

And when I met Kim Dokja in the snowfield in my dream.

Maybe, I've been imagining that this moment would come.

Han Sooyoung looked at me blankly and said, "Yes. I'm Han Sooyoung."

[Someone is activating 'Lie detection'.]

['Lie detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

Up to authentication with lie detection.

Even the thorough appearance was exactly the Han Sooyoung I knew.

The other thing is that the present Han Sooyoung is more believable than the Han Sooyoung I remember.

It gives off an indescribable atmosphere.

It felt like facing some kind of great person.

"Don’t you need to introduce yourself?"

"I am-"

"I know who you are, Cheon Inho. No..."

Han Sooyoung slightly tilted her head.

"The author of the ‘Omniscient Reader’ of planetary system Z865123."

I unknowingly clenched my fist.

"How did you know?"

"You keep stealing the items I wanted. How could I not know? As for if you’re a reader or a writer... The way you behave is a bit different from the reader's."

Seeing Han Sooyoung smiling, my fists lost their strength.

"You’re good on your own, right? I guess you read intently…"

'Read intently', those words stuck in my ears like thorns.

"It seems that other guys besides you do it quite a bit… You can’t even compare to the 'prophets' of our world line."

A face that seems to know everything.

There was no hostility in Han Sooyoung's tone. Rather, it was a tone that seemed to encourage me from the bottom of her heart.

"I guess the novel sold quite well in that world line? In some world lines, it was completely ruined."

"The reaction wasn't bad. It was a success."

"Okay?"

Han Sooyoung smiled lightly.

"I'm glad."

What is it that makes you happy?

I giggled and said.

"Until I met you, I thought I wrote the whole story."

Han Sooyoung looked at me with regret.

"Okay. But I wrote it."

I couldn't help but admit it.

The tale that ran through her body spoke.

That person is real.

It’s not me who wrote it, it's that person.

"If you wrote a story, you know. All the sentences you came up with are from the cloud."

"The sentences in the cloud were passed on in the form of inspiration. I believed it was my idea."

"That's right."

Really. Did I really not write a single sentence in this world?

As if dismissing the question, the original author of the story said.

"So, just stop here and get out of here."

Before I could even walk, one of my knees felt bent.

But on the other hand, I felt a strange sense of relief.

"You don't have to take responsibility. I'll do the rest. Stop down and rest."

Why do I believe in these words and want to quit everything?

I stumbled and asked.

"Doing something… what do you mean?"

"Are you a writer too?"

As if she didn't already know the answer, Han Sooyoung asked.

Her vague premonition came to a certainty, and her fingertips trembled anxiously.

Han Sooyoung spoke as if driven by a premonition.

"The end of this turn has already been decided. I'm just trying to speed it up a little."

The 'end of the 41st turn' I remember flashed through my mind.

「The bequest power using the 'absolute throne' fails to proceed with the scenario.」

「After losing all his comrades, he contracts with a demon to send 'Shin Yoosung' to the world line of the past.」

「Shin Yoosung' wandered around the world for over a thousand years.」

「She descended as the 'Disaster of Floods' in the world line of the past.」

At the end of this story, nothing good came of it.

It was such a world in the first place.

Han Sooyoung said as if to comfort me.

"No need to continue, no need to be sad. There are just stories like that."

I know.

This world was already over.

Through the conclusion of the 41st turn, the next incident has already 'occurred' and the 'end of the incident' must be fixed.

Only then, for the first time, does『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 begin.

I understood that too.

I understood, so I didn't understand.

"Then why were we called to this worldline?"

It was unfair.

Clearly 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, the story written by Han Sooyoung is correct.

But.

"Ordinary people were suddenly summoned to this worldline and had to fight for their lives."

Can I say that all the moments that I and the readers endured in this world are also her sentences?

"Fighting monsters you've never seen before, struggling to get food, killing others to survive."

I thought there must be a reason we came here.

It's just that we weren't chosen by chance. I believed that there must be a tie in which we, as we ought, must contribute to this story.

"Not only me, but everyone along with me did that. So I think we deserve to know why."

I thought of doing squats Kyung Sein in the corner of Geumho Station, and I remembered Dansu Ahjussi, who had nightmares calling his daughter's name.

I thought of the Killer King left in the movie to send me upstairs, and I thought of Literature Girl 64 who believed in such a Killer King and helped me.

All of them were possessing readers in this place just because they had read the Omniscient Reader.

"There are even people who have been brought here and died."

"They’re not dead. You know."

Han Sooyoung sighed lightly and added a word.

"They just returned to being 'Fragments of Kim Dokja'. They are back to their original form."

"They are no longer Kim Dokja. They are people who have already lived in another world. They each had their own lives."

"You called us."

"I didn’t call you?"

Of course, it was 'RepresentativeKimDokja' who kidnapped us, not Han Sooyoung.

However, can we really say that Han Sooyoung is irrelevant?

"I saw a video of you."

"A video of me?"

"Didn't you say, 'So far it's just a taster. A side story will start soon'?"

The memory of the theater where <Kim Dokja's Banquet> was held was still clear.

RepresentativeKimDokja, who kidnapped us, played a video of Han Sooyoung on the screen.

"I don’t know what you mean?"

Han Sooyoung narrowed her eyes, as if she didn't understand.

"I've never done anything like that. What are you talking about?"

Looking at her expression, it seems that the video was not Han Sooyoung herself.

If so, did someone disguise themselves as Han Sooyoung?

It wasn't impossible.

Because RepresentativeKimDokja had the 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit'.

RepresentativeKimDokja knew information about Kim Dokja and 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', so it would not have been impossible to imitate Han Sooyoung's tone.

But there were still unanswered questions.

"Then you have nothing to do with us coming here?"

Han Sooyoung hesitated for the first time.

"I may not be completely irrelevant, but... Anyway, I wasn't the one who called you to this world line. I didn't mean to."

"Then why are you here?"

As Han Sooyoung said, this story has already ended. Those words were more applicable to Han Sooyoung than anyone else.

"『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 is a story that has already ended. Why did you come back to this story?"

Countless universes bloomed and lost to complete a story.

There have been countless tragedies, and they have seen the end. The world line is closed.

Originally, she shouldn't have been able to come here now.

"I am."

Han Sooyoung's eyes shook. For the first time, agitation rose up in the expression of the author.

"I am a Kim Dokja-"

Sparks exploded all over her body with a sound like tsutsutsuchut.

An aftermath of probability.

The reason was simple.

「That's information she can't mention.」

Han Sooyoung's expression hardened. She looked down at the sparks running through her hand and said in a much cooler tone.

"I am under no obligation to tell you the details."

"Wait a minute."

"Hey."

I felt my blood run cold.

"I am really tired right now?"

Both of her eyes were staring at me.

"Do you know what I went through to get here?"

Seeing the cool emotion in those eyes, I took a step back without realizing it.

"I feel sorry for you, too. I feel bad for being called to a place like this, and do you think I haven't experienced a scenario? I'll find a way too, so just stay still for now."

I felt overwhelmed just by hearing the story.

It was as she said.

Han Sooyoung was someone who had already experienced scenarios. Even at the end of the scenario, a person who has reached it twice.

She said that no matter how much I and the readers knew about her story, there was no way we could do better than she did.

「Wouldn’t it be wise for me to entrust everything to Han Sooyoung?」

A weak thought appeared in my mind.

If you think about it, even when I first possessed this world, wasn't I thinking of meeting and relying on Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk?

Even if it changes to Han Sooyoung, nothing will change.

So even now, I want to believe in her and quit.

How many steps did I take back without even realizing it? I felt something touch my back.

When I turned around, Yoo Joonghyuk was standing there.

I stared blankly at Yoo Joonghyuk's still hardened face.

And at that moment.

「What I want to protect.」

I heard the story of Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who is not the Yoo Joonghyuk of the Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint I know, nor Yoo Joonghyuk of the Ways of Survival read by Kim Dokja.

「Do I still have something I want to protect?」

I could tell just by looking at his face.

[The character Yoo Joonghyuk is suffering from 'regression depression'.]

Han Sooyoung's method of overpowering Yoo Joonghyuk.

She wrote the method used by Kim Dokja in the 1863rd turn.

"You mean you’re going to do something like this?"

Unbeknownst to me, something suddenly soared inside me.

I couldn't stop talking, wondering if I deserved to say that.

"Isn’t this Yoo Joonghyuk doing nothing wrong?"

"I would have told you not to mind."

I also wanted to believe in Han Sooyoung.

However, I couldn't understand Han Sooyoung's current behavior to just ignore it.

Why didn't Han Sooyoung kill the Theater Owner?

[Your exclusive attribute effect is activated!]

Why did Han Sooyoung subdue Yoo Joonghyuk here?

I looked at the simulation controlled by Han Sooyoung and Yoo Joonghyuk connected through the Theater Owner.

「"Kim Namwoon, you can't follow me with that kind of effort."」

Yoo Joonghyuk was dreaming.

「"Lee Hyunsung. Sometimes think for yourself, act and decide."」

Even in his dreams, he was carrying out the scenarios with the determination to die.

「"Stand back, Lee Jihye. From here on out, I'm in charge."」

Losing colleagues and failing the scenario.

Not knowing that all the stories were false, Yoo Joonghyuk struggled.

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk will not be able to see the 'end' of the 41st turn in the future.

The moment I thought that far, I knew Han Sooyoung's plan.

In this world, there were too many variables that would hinder the 'end of the 41st turn'.

Me. Readers. And even Yoo Joonghyuk, who has abnormal power compared to when reading the main story.

What if there was a way to remove all those variables at once?

"You're not going to clear this theater dungeon."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

# 611 Episode 12 □□ (2)

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I continued to speak to Han Sooyoung, who did not answer.

"Aren’t you going to tie Yoo Joonghyuk here and lock him in a movie that repeats forever?"

Then, only a small part of the tragedy that will happen in this world due to Yoo Joonghyuk will occur.

If it were Han Sooyoung, she would have already sent her [Avatar] outside.

Under her plan, the world will quietly perish, and Shin Yoosung will become a lost child of the worldline and embark on a journey to become a 'disaster'.

That is the complete ending of this 41st turn designed by Han Sooyoung.

After thinking for a moment, Han Sooyoung opened her mouth.

"Yeah, right."

"Why do you have to go this far?"

"If it's a world that's going to perish anyway, why don't we reduce the pain of destruction?"

As if deciding the end of a world, Han Sooyoung continued speaking.

"You know what kind of guy Yoo Joonghyuk is in this world."

Han Sooyoung was looking at Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Not all versions of Yoo Joonghyuk are good. Yoo Joonghyuk is also human, and he makes mistakes. Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st turn is a guy who will make a lot of mistakes."

But what she was seeing was probably not the legacy of this world.

A distant shadow of a tale passed over her eyes.

From the 0th turn to the 1865th turn.

To Han Sooyoung, who wrote 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, 'Yoo Joonghyuk' may not be a character, but a phenomenon and concept.

"It's a mistake that hasn't happened yet."

I thought of the Yoo Joonghyuk who had talked to me, and the Yoo Joonghyuk who had confided in Cheon Inho during the 40th turn.

Yoo Joonghyuk wanted to see the end of this world, even by borrowing the hands of the wicked.

Yoo Joonghyuk tried to teach the people of Geumho Station how to hunt.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had left 'The Spirit of Elaine Forest' for me.

Was Yoo Joonghyuk really a bad guy?

"We can change it."

"If you do that, something worse will happen."

Something worse.

"If you change the story, another worldline will be born starting from this turn. Also, a universe of countless scenarios will be born."

I felt my heart tightening.

"You asked why I came here?"

There was quiet anger in Han Sooyoung's voice.

"I have come to bring this whole story to its conclusion. To stop this damn tragedy that never ends, no matter how many times I close it."

When I heard that, I felt sad for some reason. Maybe it was because I remembered Han Sooyoung's sentence.

「I'll keep writing the epilogue for you until the end of time, for eternity.」

Han Sooyoung, who had written that sentence for the young Kim Dokja, was now trying to write the last sentence that would end this entire world.

Maybe that was it.

I benefited from her doing that.

But I was curious about one thing.

Why did her face look so sad as she tried to write the last sentence?

"This kind of ending is unacceptable."

"Who are you?"

"I am."

Who am I?

"I am the one still writing 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, the story you started."

Han Sooyoung was silent for a moment, as if she understood what those words meant.

And she asked.

"Are you sure?"

"I am not confident."

I had never written a story because I was confident.

"But there is still a story to be told."

The moment Han Sooyoung was about to open her mouth, I kicked off the ground and ran toward her.

Whatever Han Sooyoung's purpose was, I couldn't just sit by and watch the situation.

「I must clear the 'Theater Dungeon'.」

Only then could I save Killer King.

Only then could I free the other readers who might be in danger.

Only then could I save Yoo Joonghyuk.

Han Sooyoung's left hand moved with a crackling sound like chi-chi-tsu. The [Black Flame] in her hand flew toward me, scorching the rooftop.

I breathed in as hard as I could and cried out.

"Turn into the Shield of Hercules!"

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 6' is activated!]

'Thoughts of Almost Everything' turned into a replica version of the 'Shield of Hercules' obtained from the reward room.

[Special skill 'Area Defense' is activated!]

A translucent barrier spread around the shield.

Han Sooyoung's [Black Flame] melted more than half of the shield before dispersing.

My hands and feet were searing hot, and my breathing was labored by the heat that burned all around me.

I endured the heat and opened my mouth.

"Heewon-ssi, are you there?"

Then, a voice came from behind.

"How did you know?"

Holding 'Mikazuki Munechika' in her left hand and wearing 'impossible mission' on her body, Jung Heewon was standing behind me.

I said without looking back.

"I thought it was time for you to wake up. When did you wake up?"

"From the white room earlier."

Jung Heewon chuckled. Standing beside me, she added,

"You were saying something important, so I figured I shouldn't interrupt."

"What about now?"

"I thought you would die if I didn't step in."

We smiled at each other briefly. As if her physical condition had fully recovered, Jung Heewon's whole body surged with a deep blue magical energy.

"That person is very strong."

Jung Heewon glanced at Han Sooyoung and nodded.

"I see."

I pointed to the Theater Owner in front of Han Sooyoung and said.

"The target is not her. It is the old man in front of her."

"If we get rid of that, this dungeon will end too, right?"

I nodded.

Han Sooyoung listened to our conversation in silence from a distance.

Her expression seemed to assure us that things wouldn't change no matter what we did.

As if she didn't like that attitude, Jung Heewon stepped in front of me.

"Do you remember what you said to me before I passed out? Say it one more time."

I knew what she meant and said,

"You might pass out again."

"It's frustrating, but right now, I feel like I won't be able to win unless I hear it."

Sparks flashed in Jung Heewon's eyes.

Her voice was that of someone who had already made up her mind.

If I was ever going to use it, now was my only chance.

While Han Sooyoung was slightly off guard, I opened my mouth to play the strongest card we had.

"Every enemy in front of you from now on."

Now, it was our turn to tell our story.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 6' is activated!]

"is a monster."

With those words as a signal, a wave of magical power exploded from Jung Heewon's body.

[Character Jung Heewon requests the activation of 'Hour of Judgment'.]

Then, the indirect messages from the constellations echoed in my head.

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

And.

[Hour of Judgment has been activated.]

Jung Heewon ran up the roof with a roar. The acceleration was enough to make Han Sooyoung widen her eyes.

Han Sooyoung's left hand moved hurriedly and emitted [Black Flame].

['Mikazuki Munechika's' special option 'Traces of the Four Gods' is activated!]

Jung Heewon's new weapon, which is as dark as a shadow, reached right in front of Han Sooyoung, avoiding the flames of [Black Flame].

Movements that show no hesitation.

The magical power in her right hand dyed Mikazuki Munechika's blade.

It was a perfect strike.

Jung Heewon's sword, imbued with a deep blue energy, aimed exactly at the neck of the Theater Owner.

"It's rare. This isn't the [Hour of Judgment] I know."

With the voice, Jung Heewon's sword stopped.

As if there was an invisible force of repulsion between Han Sooyoung and Jung Heewon, Jung Heewon's sword trembled in the air and was pushed away.

I belatedly realized what had happened.

[The Theater Owner attempts 'Mental Erosion'!]

During that short interval, Han Sooyoung borrowed the skill of the Theater Owner and attacked Jung Heewon.

Dammit.

"Heewon-ssi! Step back!"

Jung Heewon's eyes slowly grew cloudy.

Jung Heewon once said that among the members of <Kim Dokja's Company>, she is especially vulnerable to mental attacks.

From the beginning, there was no way she could withstand the attack of the Theater Owner.

The moment I hurriedly ran and reached out my hand toward Jung Heewon.

"Stay right there."

With Han Sooyoung's words, my vision flipped.

Han Sooyoung, who grabbed my wrist, turned me over and pinned me to the floor. An excruciating pain ran down my back, and I was choking on my breath. I could feel the story flowing through her fingertips, disrupting my energy and blood.

A level of power difference that made it not even a fight.

Blood gushed from my mouth, and my consciousness went out for a moment and then came back.

"This, that thing."

I heard Jung Heewon's voice.

When I slowly opened my eyes, I saw Jung Heewon staggering forward.

"This is—"

Blood vessels burst from her eyes, and Jung Heewon took a step forward, bleeding from her bitten lips.

Han Sooyoung had an admiring look on her face.

"You. You're a bit different from the Jung Heewon I know."

Something immediately came to mind.

Come to think of it, something similar happened in [Illusion Prison].

Even though she received the item's equipping effect, Jung Heewon defeated the specters without suffering any trauma.

「The Jung Heewon of this world has no trauma associated with the villains of Geumho Station.」

It wasn't her hatred of the bad guys that awakened her.

The Jung Heewon of the 41st turn is a person who became a 'judge' only to save me.

Han Sooyoung muttered in a low voice.

"It's surprising that this Jung Heewon is still alive... Why is the 41st turn so interesting?"

With just a moment of encounter, Han Sooyoung seemed to be blinded by the new history of Jung Heewon.

"But to think that Inho is on your side, the Jung Heewon whom I know would be sad to see this."

"What?"

"Jung Heewon. Aren't you curious what the original story was like?"

The tip of her white finger touched Jung Heewon's forehead in a magical trajectory.

[Giant Story 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' begins its storytelling.]

I could see Jung Heewon's pupils widening. I also got goosebumps on my forearms.

It wasn't clear what exactly Jung Heewon was looking at, but it wasn't hard to imagine what it was.

"See? That's the true identity of that person you believe in."

Jung Heewon was watching the story of the 3rd turn.

「"My name is Cheon Inho."」

To be precise, she was looking at the Cheon Inho of that world.

「"You're right. Scouts receive more rations. So, if you want to get food, please join the scouting party."」

The villain of Geumho Station. The one who bullied people and put Jung Heewon in danger of dying.

Cheon Inho, the leader of the Cheolsoo group.

「The guy's words did not continue. It's because Jung Heewon, who appeared from behind, pierced Cheon Inho's face from the top of his head.」

In that world, Jung Heewon killed Cheon Inho and regained her life.

The story did not end there.

Blood flowed from Jung Heewon's nose and mouth as she watched the stories of the third turn flowing like a panorama.

"This."

Looking at Jung Heewon, Han Sooyoung was making an unknown expression.

At that moment, Han Sooyoung was like a demon king, a dokkaebi, and a constellation. Han Sooyoung looked like a god.

The story of her life explained her.

The stories gathered one by one while overcoming the risk of dying countless times.

She was standing on the accumulated stories where the daily lives of <Kim Dokja's Company> and Han Sooyoung were gathered.

She was unreachable.

A story that leaves you in awe just by looking at it. At the top of the story, Han Sooyoung was omnipotent.

Like a child who effortlessly knocks down a poorly built Jenga, she was destroying Jung Heewon with her nonchalant fingers.

It felt like all the strength was draining from my body.

She said, "Look carefully at who you are trying to be loyal to. See what life you should have had."

The history of this world, our lives, built up with my crude sentences, were collapsing.

"Hallucination…"

"It's not a hallucination."

"Even if this is true."

Jung Heewon stuttered and said.

Her eyes were glistening with a terrible light.

"This world is… not that… world."

The moment she heard those words, her eyes flashed as if she had been bathed in cold water.

Power returned to her fingertips. My dizzy vision returned to its place. I fumbled on the floor and stood up.

「This world is not 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.」

Jung Heewon was right.

「Because this world has never been properly described.」

I stumbled and took one step, then two again.

Han Sooyoung turned to me as if warning me.

"If you come any closer, you will die."

I asked Han Sooyoung.

"Were you originally going to save me?"

Han Sooyoung's hand, enveloped in [Black Flame], slowly aimed at me.

Looking at her like that, I thought.

「Really, this world is not the 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 that I know.」

What I can and cannot do now. Sentences I can write and sentences I cannot write.

「A new sentence is needed in this world now.」

And a piece of blank paper, needed to write a 'sentence'.

The moment Han Sooyoung's [Black Flame] shot at me.

[You want to do something unexpected.]

I decided to write her 'sentence' against her.

[Describe your actions.]

[Consumes 5 points of probability.]

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '□□' have been met.]

The color of the world changed to achromatic and time stopped.

[Entering the ‘Snowfield’.]

And in the next moment, something that had never happened before happened.

[An error has occurred in 'Snowfield'!]

**[#□□]**

「□□?□□?□?□□?□□□?□□□□□□□?□□□?□□□?□□?□□□□□?□□□?□□□?□□…」

*Based on the current proficiency, a total of ? additional characters are possible.

[The total amount of time you can stay in 'Snowfield' is ? minutes.]

The manuscript paper in front of my eyes was all broken. Neither the remaining time nor the limited number of characters were indicated.

I blankly stared at the blank space, then suddenly smiled.

「Suddenly, Lee Hakhyun felt that everything had become free.」

As if rejecting the rule of time, only I was awake in a world where everyone stopped.

A feeling that whatever sentence I write will come true. A feeling that I can write whatever sentence I want to my heart's content.

I remembered the first sentence.

「Lee Hakhyun moved his hand.」

This snowfield was a world between the lines where all time and space were frozen. So I couldn't be physically free either.

「Then his hand moved.」

But strangely, my hand moved.

「When I took a step, my foot fell; when I clenched my fist, it clenched.」

I don't know why this happened, but maybe this was an opportunity.

If only I could use this situation to kill the Theater Owner.

This world is between the lines where only I can stay. If this is possible, I would do it without anyone interfering—

Tsutsutsutsutsutsu!

It was then that intense sparks flew in the air.

Through the sparks' bright light, someone was looking this way.

"Interesting. So this is what happens?"

The moment I heard her voice, I felt my heart sink.

Han Sooyoung was there.

"Is this your ability?"

As if protecting her, I could see the flow of letters coiling around her. She, like me, defied the restraints of time, standing freely in the center of the snowfield.

「Above the lines and sentences, only two writers have escaped the rule of time.」

At that moment, I felt the gaze of a very faintly shining star on the far side of the snowfield.

「And one reader watched it.」

I blankly looked up at the sky, then lowered my head to look at Han Sooyoung.

The stage was set, and what I had to do was clear.

There are two writers here now.

But in the end, what is recorded here.

"There is only one story."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 612 Episode 12 □□ (3)

In a face-to-face confrontation with Han Sooyoung, there was no chance of winning. The level of proficiency in scenarios, the amount of stories accumulated, and their experiences as human beings were all completely different.

「But the sentences lingering at my fingertips were telling me otherwise.」

That here, it would be different. The disadvantage remained the same, but here, it was worth a try.

As I focused my mind, I felt the pulse of the letters floating around me.

The sentences written by Han Sooyoung and rewritten by me.

The moment I reached out my hand into the air, I felt the story wrap itself around my fingertips.

「Maritime Admiral Lee Jihye, smiling brightly, was aiming her Twin Dragon Sword at me.」

The instant I grasped the sentence, a sword appeared in my hand along with a bright light.

It was the holy relic of the Maritime War God.

Lee Jihye's exclusive weapon, the Twin Dragon Sword.

「"Exterminate them, Twin Dragon Sword!"」

Lee Jihye of the 1863th turn had finally reached the edge of the scenarios after surviving hellish ordeals and undergoing training in Murim.

「She who survived up to the 95th scenario is, without a doubt, one of the top 100 strongest in 『Ways of Survival』.」

The stories Lee Jihye had accumulated were now surging in my mind.

"Lee Jihye."

Han Sooyoung, who was watching the sentence in my hand from afar, said nonchalantly.

"Okay, come on."

I took a step forward without hesitation.

Bluffing against Han Sooyoung does not work.

I immediately activated Lee Jihye's strongest skill from the 1863th turn.

「Instant Kill.」

I became a flash of lightning and rushed toward Han Sooyoung.

Quadddeuk!

A violent recoil slammed into my right arm.

Pitch-black [Black Flame] soared from Han Sooyoung's left hand, striking back against the sword strike of [Instant Kill].

As if she were the real Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, the entire floor burned black from the [Black Flame] she unleashed.

Even though a collision of power of this magnitude occurred at the very beginning of the scenarios, no probability storm was felt.

"I see what kind of world it is."

As if she had the same thoughts as me, Han Sooyoung smiled.

"Probability, huh? It doesn't matter here, right?"

In the next moment, the brilliance of pure white flames shone from Han Sooyoung's right hand.

「A sword shimmering with white flames appeared in her hand.」

I glared at the sentences wrapped around the white-flamed sword.

「Before her sword, all the surrounding flames extinguished in homage.」

Cold sweat ran down my back.

It was because I realized what sentence Han Sooyoung was trying to summon.

「Infernal flames.」

「Hellfire.」

I hurriedly came up with a new sentence, leaving Yoo Joonghyuk and Jung Heewon behind.

「"Lee Hyunsung doesn’t need a sword. Because that guy is a sword."」

The most important thing in this world was imagination.

The power of a sentence is determined by how high, sharp, and elaborate the intensity of the imagination constituting the sentence is.

「True steel will be born from tens of thousands of hardenings.」

[Steel Sword, the stigma of Steel Sword Emperor Lee Hyunsung, flooded around me and covered the entire area.]

However, with my inexperienced imagination, I could not fully protect Jung Heewon and Yoo Joonghyuk.

In the end, the pouring flames hit the frozen Yoo Joonghyuk. The flames of [Hellfire] melted the steel exterior, and I groaned as I absorbed the heat.

Han Sooyoung's [Hellfire] was much stronger and more severe than the [Steel Sword] I imagined.

When the heat subsided a bit, I caught my breath and looked back at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was covered in flames.

Yoo Joonghyuk was not hurt at all.

The flames of [Hellfire] passed by Yoo Joonghyuk in reality and burned only the armor I created.

As if my reaction was funny, Han Sooyoung said.

"You don't seem to understand the rules of this world."

An understanding came to my mind belatedly.

This is the snowfield, the space between the lines of the story.

All sentences present here are 'words not yet recorded'.

So until the record is decided, our fight has no effect outside the snowfield.

After catching my breath, Han Sooyoung asked me.

"Why are you protecting that guy? You don't even know him properly."

"This Yoo Joonghyuk..."

Why do I protect this Yoo Joonghyuk?

"...is different from the one you wrote."

Han Sooyoung wrote about Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st turn and his heartlessness.

However, the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st turn I saw was a little different from Han Sooyoung's description.

"Aren't you also vaguely aware of it? I don't know why, but this Yoo Joonghyuk is not a villain. He is not the kind of man who would abandon his comrades."

"I already wrote that, and that's what he will do. Stopping him here will avoid unnecessary sacrifices."

"Are you serious?"

Han Sooyoung answered with a short silence.

"Yes."

"I know what kind of person you are."

There comes a moment in everyone's life when you have to defend yourself by saying, "I'm not a bad person."

That's pretty exhausting.

As the history of one's life grows longer, it becomes difficult to make excuses for everything that's happened so far, and you think, what's the point anyway?

I wondered if Han Sooyoung was thinking like that.

"It doesn't matter who I am. It matters what kind of story I write."

I understood Han Sooyoung.

Han Sooyoung was a writer who had written stories solely for one person.

If she had treated all of her characters as real people, she wouldn't have been able to get to this point.

"If you want to convince me, write a sentence worthy of it."

I remembered the combat power rankings ranked by readers.

At least those who are strong enough to subdue the present Han Sooyoung.

The Oldest Dream.

Indescribable Distance.

The Apocalypse Dragon.

However, it was difficult to precisely specify their strength.

I imagined images and came up with sentences, but the sentences were rarely reproduced.

The same was true for other deities from different worlds, or even for 'Great Sage Heaven's Equal', the strongest among the myth-grade constellations.

At that moment, I met eyes with Yoo Joonghyuk, who was staring blankly into space.

Ranked by eyes filled with the black night sky.

I grabbed the sentence that came to me almost reflexively.

「Ways of Survival: The most righteous and loneliest Constellation of all.」

I could hear the black night on my back.

"The darkness that had been silent for a long time was waking up."

How about a sentence about him?

The stepfather of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

If I borrowed the power of one of Olympus' strongest three gods...

「One of the three gods of <Olympus>, 'Father of the Rich Night'.」

I felt a pitch-black darkness envelop my whole body, and my right hand began to tremble madly.

Even in the 'Snowfield', where everything was possible, it was a difficult existence to realize with my imagination.

The scythe of Hades descended in my right hand, black as if it had been carved out of the abyss.

Almost at the same time, Han Sooyoung's left hand also wrote a sentence.

「Where his spear touches, there shall be the sea's boundary.」

I felt my ankles get damp, and the snowy floor was filled with waves in an instant.

['Sea God' Poseidon.]

The black night and the vast sea collided.

As if the horizon were a boundary, my vision felt torn apart, and the world spun several times over.

When I woke up, I was on my knees on the floor gasping for breath.

"Let's just end it here. You can't beat me."

Han Sooyoung was looking down at me.

"If you leave now, I'll let you go. You don't seem to have the qualifications anyway."

Qualifications?

"Can you use [Avatar]?"

Along with Han Sooyoung's words, countless dolls appeared by her side.

Lee Jihye.

Yoo Sangah.

Lee Hyunsung.

Lee Gilyoung.

Jung Heewon.

Shin Yoosung.

Gong Pildu.

I stared blankly at those faces. Even though I knew those dolls were just Han Sooyoung's [Avatar] fakes, I felt like I was going against the entirety of <Kim Dokja's Company>.

"If you had obtained the 'Writer' attribute, you should be able to use it. You don't seem to have it."

I didn't want to admit it.

So, over and over again, I shouted inwardly.

「Avatar.」

However, [Avatar] did not activate.

Why can't I use [Avatar]?

In this world where everything is possible, why isn't that sentence mine?

"It means you're not a proper 'writer'."

I screamed and ran towards Han Sooyoung.

The bullet shot by Gong Pildu pierced my shoulder with a sharp hiss.

Spinning twice in midair, I grasped new sentences in my hands.

「Shooting arrows like rain and shooting various gun barrels, the chaos was like a thunderstorm.」

「"This is why I curse this land, but I can’t leave."」

「Therefore, Taejo is a dot, so the smallest is the greatest.」

Maritime War God.

Goryeo's First Sword.

Kyrgios.

The Maritime War God and Lee Jihye's Ghost Fleet exchanged artillery fire at the same time. A hazy sea fog obstructed the view from the continuous shelling.

I approached Han Sooyoung in an instant with Kyrgios's [Transcendence].

The moment Han Sooyoung's shadow swayed through the fog, Cheok Jungyeong's [Three Sword Style] was activated from my right hand.

「This is a sword made to deal with the sea.」

However, before it could be activated, something grabbed my ankle. It was Yoo Sangah's [Arachne's Web].

Subsequently, Lee Hyunsung's [Mountain Breaker] struck my shoulder, and Shin Yoosung's 'Chimera Dragon' breathed fire at me.

I threw myself into the sea and rolled over several times, vomiting blood.

Is this blood really my blood? Or was even this blood just letters in the story?

I heard Han Sooyoung's voice.

"Stop it. It's amazing that you, who aren't even a writer, came this far."

I looked up at her, wiping my mouth with my sleeve.

There was still a way.

A fairly effective way to persuade her, too.

My hand drifted toward my pocket, then stopped. Using it felt somehow cowardly.

I have my own way.

If I am also a writer, I have to compete with only my own sentences.

"No matter what method you use, it is useless. It's obvious what sentences you're going to write."

Han Sooyoung's eyes were shining brightly.

「Nothing new under the sun. Everything that will be written in the future is a transformation of what has already been written.」

Han Sooyoung's main stigma was finally showing up.

「Predictive Plagiarism.」

There was nothing in this world that Han Sooyoung did not know. Because she actually went through all these sentences, and she wrote them down.

"This world doesn't need a new sentence."

Watching Han Sooyoung approaching step by step, I thought of Kim Dokja.

If I could become that guy, wouldn't I be able to break this situation?

However, the sentence about Kim Dokja never came to mind. If you think about it, even if it worked, it would have been difficult to change the situation because Kim Dokja was not particularly good at fighting.

Is there really no way left for me?

In this world, isn’t there a sentence that Han Sooyoung doesn’t know about?

"Take a rest."

The moment Han Sooyoung's left hand pointed at me once again, and the gun barrels of Lee Jihye and Gong Pildu moved toward me.

There is. A sentence she doesn't know.

Like a thunderbolt, a memory was planted in my head.

It took time to put the plan into action.

I caught my breath and opened my mouth.

"... Didn't Kim Dokja come back?"

Han Sooyoung's expression hardened.

Neither of us spoke, but I could tell we were both thinking the same sentence.

「The ending of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.」

The moment when Kim Dokja's story came back, the system was revived, and Han Sooyoung laughed openly at the hospital room door.

In the meantime, I believed that Kim Dokja would return.

It was an open ending, but every sentence in the climax pointed to Kim Dokja's return.

The return of Kim Dokja was in the reader's imagination, out of reach of the author's sentences.

That's why the scene is not described.

That's why I couldn't understand why Han Sooyoung was here right now.

If Kim Dokja had returned safely, there would be no way Han Sooyoung would be here right now.

"That..."

Han Sooyoung's lips, which slowly opened, spat out strange words.

"It hasn't been decided yet."

Not decided?

I couldn't understand Han Sooyoung's words.

But at least one goal was achieved.

I bought enough time with this.

"He's—"

With a crackling sound of probability sparks, Han Sooyoung's whole body was once again engulfed in sparks. And at that moment,

「A dark red coat amidst the ruins.」

I grabbed the hidden sentence.

「Black wings protruding through the coat.」

A sentence that even Han Sooyoung, who wrote this whole world, does not know.

This was a story that did not appear in the Ways of Survival she wrote.

「'The One Who Deceived the Stars', and the 'Evil Sophist'.」

I activated [Incite], recalling the stories of the 40th turn I had seen.

「I am Cheon Inho of the 40th turn.」

Han Sooyoung looked at me with her eyes wide open.

Formidable power welled up in my whole body.

The villain who threatened Yoo Joonghyuk in the 40th turn and drove the stars to ruin.

The unprecedented Ten Evils who fought the final battle with the protagonist while holding Yoo Joonghyuk's weapon, the Black Heavenly Demon Sword.

Han Sooyoung sent me a signal as if she felt something out of the ordinary.

Gong Pildu's turret embraced fire, and Lee Jihye's [Ghost Fleet] opened fire. Yoo Sangah's threads twisted the space, and Lee Hyunsung's [Steel Sword] exploded at me.

[Story 'When All Stars Close Their Eyes' begins its storytelling.]

All the stars closed their eyes.

「The main theme is pitch-black darkness. No starlight could illuminate Cheon Inho. No miracle, no light.」

Flustered, Han Sooyoung hurriedly looked around.

「It was as if Han Sooyoung was alone.」

The moment Han Sooyoung, taken aback, raised her left hand wildly.

「The Black Heavenly Demon Sword slashed her back.」

With an intense spark, she felt the tip of her sword and came to her senses. The sword made of sentences shattered, and I rolled across the floor in a mess.

It was shallow.

However, there was a sense that it was clearly cut.

When I hurriedly got up from the floor, Han Sooyoung was looking at me with her blank eyes.

"You. What—"

A cracking sound was heard somewhere.

[Giant Story 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' shakes uneasily.]

There were fine scratches on the surface of the sentences that protected her.

「"Sooyoung-ssi! Over there!"」

It was a sentence I knew.

「I could see Lee Seolhwa's hospital room in the distance. The leisurely flowing stories did not bring them down. Stories were pouring in from the wards they knew.」

The scene drawn by the sentence was vivid in front of my eyes.

The people of <Kim Dokja's Company> were rushing to the hospital.

Their story of waking up again.

The last story of <Kim Dokja’s Company>, which has been struggling to revive just one reader for such a long time.

「The door creaks open. Faint sunlight was coming in through the wide open window.」

「The manuscripts she was editing all night were blown away by the wind and scattered dazzlingly.」

「The story she hadn't finished was there.」

A story written by Han Sooyoung, written down by me, and read by readers.

「A sentence that she definitely wanted to write someday, even if not now. Thinking of that sentence, Han Sooyoung laughed like an idiot.」

It was the 'final scene' of the 『Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint』 we know.

「This is a story for only one reader.」

"Wait. Stop! Stop!"

With the image of Han Sooyoung stretching out her hand while shouting. A bright light flowed from the snowflake.

And the next moment.

「Lee Hakhyun finally reached the end.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 613 Episode 12 □□ (4)

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I now realize what I am looking at.

[The Giant Story 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' begins its storytelling!]

It is a story after the ending that is not yet known to the world.

The scenery, which was possible only in the readers' heads, was finally unfolding in front of my eyes.

The first sentence of the story was:

「Han Sooyoung blinked blankly.」

---

Han Sooyoung blinked blankly.

What the hell happened?

「This is a story for only one reader.」

In front of her eyes, the sentence she had just thought of was floating around. Han Sooyoung recalled the events that had happened just a moment ago.

Yoo Joonghyuk had returned from his long space journey, and their stories, which they thought had disappeared, had returned.

The system had been revived.

<Kim Dokja’s Company> had reunited.

They stood in front of Kim Dokja's hospital room, which they had visited every day for the past four years.

Everyone opened the door to the hospital room.

She remembered everything up to that point.

So what the hell is this all about now?

Han Sooyoung was thrown into the middle of the snowfield out of nowhere.

What you can see from the front and back is a far-flung snowfield.

Once, during the 'Group Regression' with Yoo Joonghyuk, she had visited a place similar to this.

The memory came back, but she couldn't tell if this was the place.

"Where are we?"

Jung Heewon’s voice.

When she looked back, she saw the companions who had visited the hospital room with her sprawled on the floor.

"Wow. What? It's snowing all of a sudden."

Surprised, Lee Jihye stood up, rubbing her backside, while Lee Gilyoung looked around, his sharp eyes scanning their surroundings.

Shin Yoosung asked.

"What about Kim Dokja?"

"I don't know. I was suddenly here when I woke up."

"Could it be another scenario?"

Several years had passed since the end of the scenarios.

But was a new scenario beginning?

Yoo Sangah, repeatedly clenching and opening her fists, added.

The scent of lotus flowers came from her white fists.

"My skills are back."

Han Sooyoung also realized it.

Just like in the days when they were actively performing scenarios, her five senses were returning sharp and alive.

After already looking around, Yoo Joonghyuk landed in the air, blowing a blizzard.

"I don't feel anything. There are no enemies around."

Had the power of the Transcendents returned? A faint golden glow radiated from Yoo Joonghyuk's body.

Han Sooyoung glared at Yoo Joonghyuk secretly.

"How can you look excited?"

"Noona, Biyoo isn't here."

At Shin Yoosung's words, the companions looked around. Of all those who had gone to the hospital room together, only Biyoo was missing.

How did it happen?

They were definitely together until they opened the door to the hospital room.

Tsutsutsutsut!

It was then that sparks flew out of the air.

As if a system message was heard.

[Congratulations.]

[You have cleared all scenarios.]

[You deserve to see the ■■ of everything.]

With the message, two portals appeared swirling in front of their eyes.

Lee Gilyoung asked.

"Huh? A portal?"

"Gilyoung-ah, step back."

Lee Hyunsung, who stepped forward as if protecting the children, took the lead and inspected the entrance to the portal. Beyond the two portals, the landscape swirled and shook.

The flickering landscape resembled the hospital room they knew.

The only difference was that a person's shadow could be seen in only one of the two hospital rooms.

Lee Hyunsung muttered in confusion.

"That shadow..."

"No way."

The moment Lee Gilyoung approached the portal with a bewildered face.

[Baat!]

Biyoo, who had disappeared into thin air, reappeared. Biyoo pulled Lee Gilyoung's hair and hurriedly spoke to him.

[Baaat! Don't just go in blindly! Listen to me first! There's a problem!]

"Problem?"

Biyoo, who had caught the companions' attention, sighed softly. Looking at the portal with complex eyes, she said something shocking.

[The 'end' of the universe has been split into two.]

…

Hearing Biyoo's explanation, the group stood blankly. The first to react was Han Sooyoung.

"So, to sum up what happened now, it would be something like this."

Han Sooyoung looked up at the snow pouring from the sky and started talking.

"One. Yoo Joonghyuk spread the novel I wrote across the universe."

Han Sooyoung recalled the memory of the day she first wrote 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

Together with the companions, she had remembered and recorded their old stories, writing a story of mourning for Kim Dokja.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who received the story, crossed the worldline and finally succeeded in telling the story to the fragments of Kim Dokja in other worlds.

"Two. The fragments of 'Kim Dokja' scattered throughout the universe began to read our story, and they even imagined an ending that I did not write."

The efforts of the party reached the end of the universe safely. Kim Dokja's fragments have recovered the story she wrote and the memories they had lost.

"Third, the portals in front of us are the 'endings'."

The fragments of Kim Dokja scattered across the worldlines are the 'Oldest Dreams' who imagined the ending of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

Up until this point, there had been no problems, rather, it was as planned.

The problem is this.

"Why are there two endings?"

Biyoo let out a low sigh and replied.

[Because there are two 'endings' they imagined.]

Biyoo pointed to the first portal.

[One is the ending of ahjussi returning.]

In the hospital room inside the portal, a shadow resembling Kim Dokja was floating.

[The other is the ending where ahjussi did not return.]

She said, this time pointing to the other portal.

It was obviously the same hospital room as the first one, but there was no shadow of Kim Dokja on the bed.

The companions did not speak for a long time.

"Why..."

Han Sooyoung muttered.

"How could that be?"

How can you imagine 'two endings' after reading all the stories?

Despite knowing the answer, Han Sooyoung had to ask. Then the answer she expected came back.

[The fragments of ahjussi scattered across the worldlines are not the 'Dokja-ahjussi' we remember.]

Countless readers read the story and imagined the ending.

One is the ending in which 'Kim Dokja' returns.

And the other is the ending where 'Kim Dokja' cannot return.

[They are free to imagine what they think, even if they read the same story. It is a miracle that the ending is compressed into two.]

Biyoo was right.

Even though so many people have read and imagined the story, they can only see the endings right in front of them. Even the word miracle is not enough.

Jung Heewon opened her mouth.

"It's been hard getting here."

She said again, shaking her head.

"I wonder if I should have done this much."

Two endings were given to them.

At least one of them had an obvious happy ending.

Jung Heewon looked up.

"I'm going through the first portal."

She looked at her companions as if to confirm her choice.

"No one's having any strange thoughts, right? If I go through the first one, I can meet Dokja-ssi again. Right, Biyoo?"

[Probably.]

"Is the Kim Dokja in there the 'Kim Dokja' that we remember?"

[I don't know.]

"You don't know?"

[Because I'm not the 'Oldest Dream'.]

Biyoo said, then thought for a while and added.

[But it's the 'Kim Dokja' of your fragments that brought him back, so it must be the 'Kim Dokja' we remember.]

"Good, now that we're in agreement."

Jung Heewon gestured to others, as if afraid to continue thinking about it.

"What are you all waiting for? We can meet Dokja-ssi again and the Dokja-ssi we remember is on the other side."

Shin Yoosung looked up with tears in her eyes. Lee Gilyoung, Lee Hyunsung and Lee Seolhwa.... Everyone seemed to have made up their minds.

"I'm not going."

Han Sooyoung said.

Jung Heewon narrowed her eyes and looked at Han Sooyoung: "You, what...?"

"The first portal must be a trap, it's too strange."

"It's not a trap..."

"Have you forgotten what happened on the subway?"

Han Sooyoung's words made Jung Heewon stop.

"At that time, it was also like that. We were deceived by a fake Kim Dokja."

Han Sooyoung's words changed the facial expressions of the group.

As she said, they had been tricked by Kim Dokja's avatar once before.

On the subway ride back from the final scenario, he had left his avatar with 49% of his memories in the hands of his companions and set out on his journey as the 'Oldest Dream'.

"What are you going to do if you go through the first portal and it ends up being an incomplete Kim Dokja again? Are you going to believe that this time it is Kim Dokja?"

"Do not talk to me like that, will you?"

Jung Heewon spoke in a voice that sounded as if she was holding back anger.

"I have said it before, no matter how much he remembers, Kim Dokja is still Kim Dokja, and even if it repeats, it's still his choice."

"You're being ridiculous again..."

"What if you are wrong?"

"What?"

"What if you choose the second portal, and you never get to see Dokja-ssi?"

"That's not going to happen."

"Han Sooyoung."

Jung Heewon let out a deep sigh, and then spoke in a determined tone:

"We aren't going to find him. We cannot have '100% Kim Dokja'."

Han Sooyoung's expression hardened.

"No one can have everything from another human being."

Han Sooyoung pursed her lips in a small smile. She had a little tic.

Who doesn't know that? Who doesn't understand such an obvious statement?

"I can't admit it."

Han Sooyoung's clenched fists trembled.

"How dare he read everything I wrote, and not come back?"

"Hey, you..."

Han Sooyoung said, shaking off Jung Heewon's grip on her shoulder.

"If you want to go to the first portal, it is your choice."

Han Sooyoung knew.

The choice she was making, perhaps, was the worst.

But she had always lived like this.

No matter how many dozens or hundreds of times she was asked to choose, she made the same decision over and over again.

Taking a slow step, Han Sooyoung said.

"If he didn't come back, there must be a reason why he didn't. I need to know why."

She stepped forward.

"I'm going to find him and bring him back one way or another. I am sick of playing this game of numbers, whether it's 49% or 51%, I need 100% or nothing."

And she took another step.

"And I'm going to go after each and every one of you, 'Kim Dokja's fragments,' who imagined that shitty ending, and I'm going to torture you until you write a 'proper

ending'."

"Han Sooyoung! What the hell...?"

"What I am saying is."

Han Sooyoung looked back.

The story she had lived, the story that had accompanied her, was there.

From the first scenario to the last, she and her life together with everyone.

Her companions, whom she would not change for anything.

That is why she understands their happiness.

"Take care of yourselves."

She smiled and walked through the portal. The letters swirled in the air and soon she merged with them.

Perhaps her assumptions were wrong.

Maybe readers weren't imagining a tragic ending, maybe something had gone really wrong and Kim Dokja hadn't come back because she hadn't been lucky.

In any case, Han Sooyoung was not worried.

She would write again.

She's a writer and writing is her job.

As long as there is someone who reads it, she can write forever.

Now that she has regained the power of the system, she can write again and convince the 'fragments of Kim Dokja'.

None of the fragments of Kim Dokja scattered across all world lines will imagine an unhappy ending.

When Han Sooyoung woke up, she found herself in front of a hospital room door.

As she blankly lifted her head, she heard a voice beside her.

"How long are you going to be standing there?"

When she turned around, she saw Yoo Joonghyuk standing by the closed door of the hospital room.

"What? When did you arrive?"

"When you were still talking nonsense."

Something moved on Yoo Joonghyuk's shoulder, and Biyoo poked her head out.

[Baat.]

Han Sooyoung opened her mouth in a daze.

She wasn't alone.

These two had crossed the portal with her.

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Han Sooyoung asked.

"Why did you come?"

It was a chance to finally make up for their long years.

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk abandoned the opportunity and came here with Biyoo.

"If he’s here."

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the door of the hospital room and continued.

"And I had a hunch that he was going to do something strange."

"You know you can’t return, right?"

A regressor who has lived for a long time.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had stopped even regressing, made the same choice as her at the end of this story.

Han Sooyoung couldn't help but open her mouth.

"Well, even if you go through the first door, you'll end up unemployed again. You say you don't even play games anymore?"

"I will open it this time."

Yoo Joonghyuk's rough palm touched the doorknob of the hospital room.

The moment the door moved slowly, Han Sooyoung grabbed Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Wait for a sec."

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at Han Sooyoung and said.

"Anyway, there will be no one."

"I know."

This is a world where 'Kim Dokja' never returned. So even if he opens the door to the hospital room, Kim Dokja will not be there.

After completing her mental preparation, Han Sooyoung sighed lightly.

"Open it."

In the end, in order to get Kim Dokja back, they had to start by 'losing Kim Dokja'.

Even so, Han Sooyoung could not completely abandon hope.

Maybe Biyoo had been wrong. What if all this was just a cruel prank by Kim Dokja?

Like a sentence forgotten and added belatedly, what if the person she'd long been looking for was within the unfolding scenery...?

The wind blew through her hair through the open window.

As expected, no one was on the bed.

But it wasn't anything.

Han Sooyoung, like someone who spilled something on herself, approached the bed with Yoo Joonghyuk.

A small note was left on the sunken bed, as if someone had been sitting there a while ago.

A memo neatly written in a familiar handwriting.

—There's a story I haven't read yet. I'll be right back.

Han Sooyoung read the note over and over again.

This sentence was not a lie.

She heard Yoo Joonghyuk breathe lightly.

Han Sooyoung sat down holding the memo in her arms without even realizing it.

Kim Dokja did not return.

Even so, Han Sooyoung seemed to forgive him.

"You damn child..."

He was obviously alive.

They can't see him, but somewhere far away in the universe.

Kim Dokja is still reading an unfinished story.

---

In the faint sparks, I read the story of Han Sooyoung.

「"I will find him with Biyoo. Now that the system is open, I can search the bottom of the world line again."」

Stories that are heard in sparsely fragmented forms.

Among them, there was the voice of Yoo Joonghyuk, the voice of Han Sooyoung, and a voice whose identity was unknown.

「"Then check the world line over there..."」

「"If he's the real Dokja, he'd definitely be on this side, right?"」

.....

「"If it's the price for telling you where Kim Dokja is, how about it?"」

Han Sooyoung's hardened face could be seen over the flowing story.

Listening to the gradually fading voices of the story, I opened my mouth.

"It would have been fine if you had chosen the first 'portal'."

She could have been happy.

She could have met Kim Dokja again and had the long-awaited ending.

"There must be an ending like that somewhere."

Han Sooyoung answered as she watched the disappearing sentences.

A 'happy ending' already existed.

However, she did not choose that option.

"There are two options. One is the end for anyone to see, and the other is somewhat suspicious. In such a situation, it is obvious what the real Kim Dokja would choose. Because that damn guy likes 'stories' more than anyone else."

In a sense, her choice was not wrong. She eventually found the traces of Kim Dokja and came this far.

"Kim Dokja can make his imagination real. His dreams become reality. The Kim Dokja in the 'First Portal' must have been real too."

"Maybe he was."

Han Sooyoung nodded.

Since she acknowledged that possibility as well, she probably did not force her choice on Jung Heewon or the other members of <Kim Dokja's Company>.

However, Han Sooyoung must have come up with another possibility.

A possibility that Kim Dokja was alone with the tragedy of the far-off universe, while <Kim Dokja’s Company> was confined in happy memories.

She, with her great imagination, couldn't bear to turn away from that possibility.

"I just picked the one I thought was more like Kim Dokja."

I was a bit envious of Kim Dokja at the upright confidence felt in her tone.

"Is Kim Dokja in this world?"

"I don't know either, but... at least he can see this world."

At last, her Giant Story stopped its storytelling. The wound I had inflicted on the story had been repaired.

"I don't like it. Because this isn't a story I wrote."

Her story, which she once started, is now flowing into a development she does not know.

Han Sooyoung and I looked up at the sky at the same time. The color was slowly returning to the sky of the 'Snowfield', which had been entirely achromatic.

The skill's time limit was already running out.

"For him to come back, this story must end."

Because it was right after seeing her Giant Story, I could agree with her words to some extent.

But that wasn't the end, at least not now.

That's why I constantly wrote sentences in my head.

An enormous amount of probability was consumed.

[You have described content lacking in probability.]

[The success rate of reproducing this description is 8%.]

[You have described content lacking in probability.]

[The success rate of reproducing this description is 1%.]

Throughout the fight with Han Sooyoung, I repeatedly wrote and erased sentences.

In order to find a 'sentence' that would convince the Han Sooyoung in front of me.

How many sentences did I edit and rewrite?

[Possible contents have been described.]

[The description has a 78% success rate of reproduction.]

I gambled to increase my success rate. Just like the day I first met Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st turn, I raised my probability by sacrificing my arms.

[The title of the scene is changed due to the sentence you added.]

I bet everything I could write.

[The success rate of reproducing this description is 95%.]

[You can no longer increase your success rate.]

[Read reader feedback.]

[No reader feedback exists.]

[Every 'reader' in the theater checks out your story.]

[You have secured additional probability with more than a certain number of recommendations.]

I said while looking at the sentence of the snowfield I wrote.

"Kim Dokja may want to continue watching the story."

"Maybe, but this story is not worth it."

"What if Kim Dokja’s taste has changed? What if the story you wrote is no longer interesting?"

"That."

Han Sooyoung smiled and asked.

"Are you serious?"

The scenery of the snowfield collapsed with a cooing sound.

[Exiting the 'Snowfield'.]

The stopped time started to flow again.

Taking advantage of Han Sooyoung's surprise, I shouted at Jung Heewon.

"Heewon-ssi!"

Jung Heewon, who was still resisting the mental attack, turned to me with a creak.

I wasn't sure if I could give more mental load to a target who had already been affected by [Incite].

Jung Heewon's lips said.

'Inho-ssi. Hurry.'

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 6' is activated!]

I took a deep breath and spoke all at once.

"You are unaffected by mental attacks from now on!"

[Incarnation 'Jung Heewon' receives the effect of 'Incite'!]

[Incarnation 'Jung Heewon' is already under the effect of 'Incite'!]

[The effect of 'Incite' is multiplied and the penalty is raised!]

[The duration of 'Incite' is extremely short!]

Jung Heewon, who vomited blood from her mouth, swung her sword forward again.

The mental attacks from the Theater Owner could no longer affect her.

"It's amazing. Can you do something like this with 'Incite'?"

Han Sooyoung said while blocking Jung Heewon's sword with her left hand wrapped in [Black Flame].

"But this is going to kill Jung Heewon, you know?"

Jung Heewon, whose complexion turned pale, growled.

"I'm not dying."

Perhaps realizing she couldn't approach the Theater Owner without dealing with Han Sooyoung, Jung Heewon's [Kendo] shifted its trajectory.

[Hour of Judgment] poured out explosive fighting power in a short period of time. In addition, her refined [Kendo] was added to the mix.

Her sword, capable of cutting even 7th grade monsters in an instant, launched an all-out offensive at Han Sooyoung.

"Look at this."

It's good that Han Sooyoung was pushed away for a moment by that non-stop offensive.

I ran quickly and shouted.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 6' is activated!]

"Turn into 'Broken Faith'!"

Along with my words, 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' emitted a bright light and formed the shape of a sword. It was the mimicry form obtained when defeating the script writer.

['Thoughts of Almost Everything' mimics Broken Faith (Mass-Production Type)!]

Before I knew it, the simulation was right in front of me.

Han Sooyoung, who found me belatedly, narrowed her eyes.

"I—"

Broken Faith's special option was 'Blade of Faith'.

But I didn't have strong qigong skills, so I couldn't use 'Blade of Faith'.

If it was before, it would have been the case.

I raised the mana of my whole body and focused it on my broken faith.

「"Please save my brother."」

It is a skill that Literature Girl 64 passed on to me.

[Exclusive skill 'White Blue Steel Lv. 1' is activated!]

[Activates 'Blade of Faith'!]

The ether blade surged, scattering dazzling white light, and the Theater Owner reflexively crouched.

With a bright flash, both arms of the Theater Owner flew in the air.

I continued to wield my sword while reciting an incantation.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 6' is activated!]

"...am Yoo Joonghyuk."

The moment the trail of the sword finally reached the neck of the Theater Owner, someone pulled my back strongly.

When were they summoned?

Two of Han Sooyoung's [Avatars] were holding onto my shoulders. What followed was a strong jolt in my side and shin. The blade flew through the air in an instant, and I knelt on the floor.

As I collapsed with dizziness, I saw Jung Heewon, who had also vomited blood, lose consciousness and pass out.

[The effect of 'Incite' ends.]

An enormous recoil engulfed Jung Heewon's entire body.

"It was a failure," she muttered.

Despite fighting against her strong limitations, it was not enough to defeat Han Sooyoung.

Han Sooyoung let out a light sigh and said.

"It was a little dangerous."

I realized how big the difference between her and my capabilities was.

Feeling her victory, Han Sooyoung looked down at me and said.

"Now you know the difference, right?"

I knew from the beginning.

I probably won't be able to beat Han Sooyoung even if a truck comes.

So I thought.

"It doesn't have to be me who wins."

An enormous reverberation felt from behind. Han Sooyoung, her eyes wide open, looked behind me.

A man in a black coat was waking up from his deep depression.

"The person who ends the story is the protagonist of this story."

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 6' is activated!]

「"You are Yoo Joonghyuk."」

The effect of [Incite], used earlier when cutting off the arms of the Theater Owner, was finally activating.

Yoo Joonghyuk started running. He didn't seem to be completely out of his 'Regression Depression' yet, but he knew what he had to do.

The spear held in his hand drew destructive magic in a straight line.

Han Sooyoung, in a hurry, pulled out her sword for the first time.

I admired the pure white sword in her hand.

Han Sooyoung also made that.

'Unbreakable Faith.'

I don't know how it was made.

However, unlike me, her sword was neither mass-produced nor fake, but real.

The moment I saw the dazzling brilliance of the sword, I shuddered.

「The author of this story is also Han Sooyoung.」

Perhaps I will never become a writer like her in my whole life.

I let go of the [Avatar] that was holding me back, exploding my whole body's mana. Then, holding onto the 'Broken Faith' that had fallen on the floor, I ran towards Han Sooyoung.

Han Sooyoung, locked in a fierce clash with Yoo Joonghyuk, looked back at me in surprise.

"You were supposed to try to convince me, right?"

The two blades of faith collided fiercely.

"Are you ready to be convinced?"

Han Sooyoung's eyes shook.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who did not miss the opportunity, leisurely passed by us and moved to end the Theater Owner.

Tsutsutsutsutsutsutsu!

Embarrassed, Han Sooyoung shouted at me.

Usually, Han Sooyoung would be able to shake me off easily and stand in Yoo Joonghyuk's way.

But this time, it was impossible.

「Because this is such a story.」

Han Sooyoung finally realized what was going on.

"You, please."

Perhaps my role in this story is, at best, a bridge.

"If you're a writer, you'd know."

But even that was enough.

If only one more reader could survive. If they can see the end of the story after going through the 'main story' and the 'side stories'.

"You're not trying to finish the story, you're giving up."

I am willing to be broken to complete this story.

Han Sooyoung's 'Unbreakable Faith' spat out a violent [Black Flame], and I desperately blocked its path.

The blade of 'Broken Faith' crumbled helplessly, and soon I felt the 'Blade of Faith' disappear.

「There is no such thing as one magic sentence that will convince someone.」

Like a writer refining the end of a pre-determined story, I smiled at Han Sooyoung.

「Because all miracles require the price of probability.」

The sound of Yoo Joonghyuk's spear piercing the head of the Theater Owner echoed.

Suddenly, Kim Dokja's face came to mind.

Is that guy still reading this story?

Come to think of it, I always envied him.

「Then, did I get a little closer to him?」

Reflecting on those thoughts, I realized my limits.

[Succeeded in reproducing the scene.]

The moment the sharp blade pierced my chest, I remembered one thing I had forgotten.

「Tell that guy.」

I managed to get my hands into my pockets, but my arms weren't strong.

In the distance, the Theater Owner dissolved, and Yoo Joonghyuk collapsed.

The dome surrounding the rooftop garden was lifted.

[Someone has cleared the Theater Dungeon.]

My vision was blurred.

My heart grew colder and my whole body lost strength. I just fell to the floor.

The sound of Han Sooyoung shouting something came like an echo.

「The readers died and became 'little Kim Dokjas'.」

In the slowly fading consciousness, I saw the scenery of the night sky.

「Then what will I become after I die?」

What came to my mind at the last moment was, unexpectedly, the last sentence of my debut work.

「He walked towards his origin like that.」

I closed my eyes, holding the item in my pocket that I couldn't deliver.

There seemed to be a lemon scent somewhere.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 615 Episode 12 □□ (6)

Han Sooyoung could not understand the situation unfolding before her eyes.

"What the hell?"

She looked down at Cheon Inho, collapsed on the ground.

Blood poured relentlessly from his chest, where 'Unbreakable Faith' had pierced straight through.

It was an irreversible wound.

There was already too much blood pooling across the floor. Whether it was the 'Ellain Forest Essence' or anything else, nothing she could do now would bring him back.

"You, why the hell?"

The writer of ORV from another worldline, wearing Cheon Inho's face.

Han Sooyoung understood his cause and his desperate desire to save his readers.

"I... I said I would do something, didn't I?"

This world was the Star Stream.

Once a scenario began, someone's sacrifice was inevitable.

The outcome of 'Destruction' was predetermined, so Han Sooyoung had decided to end it as quickly as possible with minimal sacrifice.

She knew it would be harsh on the characters.

However, leaving things as they were would lead to an even greater tragedy in this round, and trying to change the ending could cause a catastrophe across all worldlines.

Han Sooyoung took on the role of a villain once again.

She designed an ending with minimal pain.

Her plan was to retrieve the souls of the possessed individuals caught up in the scenarios and return them to their original worldline with minimal loss.

Everything went smoothly until that guy appeared.

「If you are a writer, you would know.」

The words he'd left behind echoed endlessly through her mind.

「You're not trying to finish the story, you're giving up.」

Han Sooyoung gasped for breath as she felt the probability.

Why did he say that? Why did he jump in front of her?

「You were supposed to try to convince me, right?」

She never intended to kill him. If that had been her plan, she would have severed his neck right away.

Leveling a path of tragedy, her 'Unbreakable Faith' pierced right through his chest.

「Are you ready to be convinced?」

She tried to alter the sword's trajectory mid-strike, again and again, but her muscles wouldn't obey, as if the world itself were demanding his death.

'No way.'

Han Sooyoung recalled the achromatic landscape that had unfolded moments before.

What if that was this guy's 'skill'?

What if he had a skill that created the events he desired, but at the cost of probability? What if, as the price of that probability, he sacrificed himself?

「Han Sooyoung knew someone who had sacrificed himself in this way.」

Han Sooyoung staggered in the rising dizziness, slowly bending down toward the fallen Cheon Inho.

She wanted to ask him a question before he died. Why the hell did he do this?

Then, Cheon Inho's hand slipped out of his pocket with a thud. In his hand was a lollipop of a somewhat familiar shape.

As if she had stumbled upon an inexplicable sentence written in the most unexpected place, Han Sooyoung stared blankly down at the candy.

Slowly, she reached out her hand.

Sparks flew with a crackling sound of 'Tsutsutsu'. Stories spilled from the lollipop in his hand, like something long sealed finally breaking open.

A story?

It couldn't be. The third main scenario was only just about to end.

Unless he's a special case like her, there's no way an incarnation could have already acquired a 'story'—

「"What are you doing? Hurry up and get ready! Did you forget where we're going today?"」

Something incomprehensible happened.

Those were definitely her words, her voice.

But why did this guy have a story related to her?

「"Is this pizza?"」

「"It's chicken, idiot."」

「Today was the first day of <Kim Dokja's Company>'s outing.」

The voices flowing out were familiar. All of them were voices she knew. These were sentences she knew.

「"It's so cold, do we really have to eat by the Han River?"」

Her mind grew increasingly confused.

「"Kim Dokja."」

「"Huh?"」

「"You don't read it that much these days."」

A memory vividly surfaced in her mind.

She had definitely had that conversation with Kim Dokja before.

「"Oh, yes. I have to read it."」

An outing to the Han River some time ago.

Huddled together with her companions, she had a conversation with Kim Dokja about TWSA. She had asked Kim Dokja something about Ways of Survival.

「"But Kim Dokja."」

「"Huh?"」

「"That kind of thing doesn't come up in the 3rd round of Ways of Survival."」

Kim Dokja couldn't answer.

「"Hey. Who the hell are you?"」

Slowly, a chill ran through her heart, and she struggled to breathe. From the first moment she saw him, she had thought something was off.

Who the hell is this Cheon Inho?

She knew that he was an author of ORV from another worldline, but there were too many strange things to ignore about him to simply dismiss it like that.

「"If you have 'Avatar', isn't there a very easy way to check it?"」

Han Sooyoung reached for the lemon candy with trembling fingertips.

「"The person who will read my novel... is not you."」

Stories flowed like blood from a burst wound.

It was a story that even Han Sooyoung, who wrote 『Ways of Survival』, did not know.

「He walked toward his origin like that.」

It was a story no one had ever read, existing between the lines of the sentences she had written.

---

Few people remember the moment they were first born.

For me, it was the same.

「Kim Dokja.」

People called me that, and I introduced myself that way too.

An only child.

Bearing the name my father had given me, I lived a life of living up to it.

I have always done everything alone, eating alone, working alone, sleeping alone.

Perhaps that was why...

When I was no longer 'alone' for the first time, I heard strange words.

「"Hey. Who are you?"」

A colleague I had always trusted, the person I thought maybe who could understand me best in the world.

It wasn’t true.

She easily overpowered me and threw me onto the cold floor.

Then she told the others that I was an ‘avatar’.

I didn't understand.

Surely, just moments ago, we ate together, laughed, and chatted. Why are you suddenly saying such things to me?

The reason was simple.

I couldn't properly remember a certain novel.

Thinking it was a trivial misunderstanding, I smiled as usual and said,

「"Han Sooyoung. I'm sorry, but I don't really remember it well. I haven't been reading 'Ways of Survival' lately."」

The woman's dagger flew through the air, and blood burst from my shoulder blades.

The companions criticized her.

They defended me, saying I wasn't fake. Avatars don't bleed.

Still, she did not back down.

「"If I cut your throat, I'll know. Avatars keep moving even after their throats are cut off."」

The moment my eyes met hers, I felt a cold chill run down my spine.

And I thought.

「Maybe, I'm really not Kim Dokja after all.」

My memory of that day isn't clear.

Only that the wound hurt quite a bit.

That even though it was a shallow wound, the blood wouldn't stop flowing.

That I collapsed right there.

Only those facts remain vaguely in my mind.

「"Dokja-ssi, are you okay?"」

Even after that day, the group continued to call me 'Kim Dokja'.

But every time I heard that name, I felt myself drifting further away from my own identity.

「"You probably just lost your memory because you were tired. Don’t worry too much."」

Even as I was being comforted, I felt confused.

「What on earth did I forget?」

I couldn't tell.

People who forget their memories don't remember what they've forgotten.

But the moment I realized I 'forgot something', things started to feel wrong.

My complexion grew worse by the day, and my vivid memories were fading away.

I became increasingly afraid.

「"Yoo Sangah-ssi, I am not a fake."」

「"Yes. I know."」

My companion held my hand with a warm smile. But for some reason, that smile felt unfamiliar to me.

The companion's smile was not directed at me, but rather seemed to be accidentally placed on the empty seat where the 'real Kim Dokja' was.

The time I slept became longer, and I often listened to my companions in my hazy dreams.

「"Dokja-ssi, can you stand up for a second? If you keep lying down, your back will get ruined."」

「"How about doing some gymnastics with me?"」

「"Will he be okay like this? I’ll bring a story pack just in case."」

The party members did not interrogate or accuse me.

Rather, they were discussing a possibility.

「"Heewon-ssi, have you heard of Sooyoung's plan?"」

「"If Dokja-ssi's memories truly split apart... and if the real Dokja-ssi is still out there somewhere..."」

「"Do you think that is possible?"」

The companion who first suspected me also visited my hospital room. Most of her visits were late at night.

In my languid consciousness, I often felt a hand pulling up the blanket.

She stared at me for a long time in the dark, then quietly disappeared from my hospital room by the time dawn came.

「"It's rice, Kim Dokja."」

Sometimes, when I woke up, there was someone who brought me food.

I thought as I hurriedly finished my meal in extreme hunger.

I must have eaten this kind of dish a few times while going through the scenarios.

Why do I have no memory?

「"Someone once said this."」

The man glared at me with his sullen face and said.

「"Every human being suffers from amnesia."」

After saying that, the man stared at the clock hanging in the hospital room for a long time.

I watched the clock with him. I watched the second hand move, then the minute hand follow.

「"You don't have to be anything. It only matters what you want to be."」

I don't know if the words affected me or not. However, when I woke up the next day, I said something strange to the group.

「"I also want to help find the 'real Kim Dokja'."」

「"Dokja-ssi, don't say that. There is no such thing as real or fake. You are—"」

Of course, I didn't come to believe that there was a 'real' one.

I just wanted to know.

If the 'real Kim Dokja' did not exist, the fact that I was real would naturally be proven.

The idea that I was only an [Avatar]... that the real Kim Dokja was still trapped in the subway of the final scenario, dreaming... all those ridiculous hopes would eventually vanish from the companions' minds.

「"Please let me join the plan."」

<Kim Dokja's Company>'s journey to recover the lost 'Kim Dokja'.

And so, I crossed over with the companions into the worldline of the 1865th round.

I didn't do a great job, but I watched my companions throughout the scenarios.

Seeing my companions carry out hellish scenarios from scratch, I often felt an indescribable emotion.

「"Wow, is that the method Dokja used?"」

My companions silently performed the scenario.

As the scenario progressed, they each found the 'Kim Dokja' they were looking for.

「"This recipe was told to me by that ahjussi."」

In every moment of theirs, there was a 'Kim Dokja' I couldn't remember.

「Did he always do all this alone?」

While watching their story, I naturally realized a certain fact.

「This wasn't my story.」

It wasn't up to me to decide whether I was real or fake.

「"Dokja-ssi, are you okay? Stay right behind us. Leave this to us."」

They were sympathetic.

「"We'll be fine on our own this time."」

I was taken care of.

「"Now it's our turn to give it back."」

Even that, perhaps, was not what I deserved.

After so many years, the party finally faced the end of the world.

Something in me knew. And for the first time, I put that feeling into words.

「"The other me might not want this. The story... ended there..."」

It was my last struggle and plea.

Please don't open it.

Please don't open that door, the last car of the subway.

Then the woman answered.

「"Let's meet that other you and ask him."」

In that moment, I sensed my role in the story.

「"If this is the story you all want..."」

Finally, the last subway car door opened, and I finally faced the sight I feared.

「There was Kim Dokja, whom the party had been looking for.」

Kim Dokja who had become like a child.

Kim Dokja, losing his memory just like me. But the moment I saw Kim Dokja, I realized.

「That Kim Dokja is the real Kim Dokja.」

「"Ah... Ah, I..."」

Like a satellite drawn by a star’s gravitational pull, my body moved towards Kim Dokja.

The memories I held shattered into pieces, and were sucked into the Kim Dokja in front of me.

As I felt my body vanish, I thought:

Then who was I?

「Dokja-ssi!」

I was Kim Dokja.

「"Kim Dokja!"」

But not the Kim Dokja this world wanted.

「"Kim Dok...!"」

In the final moment before my consciousness faded, I thought:

「If I could be born again.」

A delusion, or so everyone believed. An impossible wish that only the real Kim Dokja could dream of.

「At least, I hope it's not as Kim Dokja.」

I imagined a distant universe, utterly unreachable in this world, and an unnamed being born within it.

A creature that no one in <Kim Dokja’s Company> would recognize, one that had nothing to do with Kim Dokja.

「I also want to have my own story.」

There was a sound like something exploding, and in the next instant, my consciousness shattered into fragments and scattered across the universe.

However, the largest fragment of consciousness that formed my core did not completely dissipate, ultimately becoming a meteor.

The meteor set out on a very long voyage. Crossing the edge of the worldline again and again, it drifted into the unknown depths of the universe.

How much longer did I sail like that?

The meteor stopped its journey.

「There was a planet that looked just like I imagined.」

The meteor fell toward the planet, shattering into even smaller fragments of soul.

Then it entered the body of a newborn baby at the planet's edge.

「"Why isn’t our baby crying?"」

A voice came, muffled and distant. I squeezed out my last strength and burst into a weary cry.

Then someone hugged me tightly.

「"Oh, he cried!"」

I was quietly wrapped in a blanket and placed on the bed.

Maybe it's because I lost all my memories.

Or was it because the long journey was exhausting? I immediately fell into a deep sleep.

And when I awoke again, people called me by a name I had never heard before.

「"Lee Hakhyun. Your name is Lee Hakhyun."」

Finally, my wish came true.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 616 Episode 12 □□ (7)

Han Sooyoung collapsed to the ground.

The man's hands were drained of all color, and the sentences, crumbling like dust from his fingertips, whispered in her ears.

「He was once Kim Dokja.」

It couldn't be.

Yet no matter how many times she shook her head in denial, the reality before her eyes did not change.

「The 49% of Kim Dokja she had cut down with her own hands.」

When the fragments of Kim Dokja scattered across the universe, she had considered the possibility that such an existence might exist.

That the Kim Dokja she had thought was a mere [Avatar] might also have been reborn somewhere far beyond the distant reaches of the cosmos, reduced to a tiny fragment.

「"Oh my, our son is so impressive."」

In that universe, he would live a new life under a new name.

「"Honey, I guess he likes books. He will become a scholar, right?"」

Unlike Kim Dokja, he would have grown up in a warm family, cherished by his parents.

「"Waaaaah—"」

Maybe he cried after losing his first love.

「"Kuu. Kut. Kut. Love... only makes people weak."」

He would have indulged in youthful recklessness, creating embarrassing memories.

「"Hakhyun, what's your dream?"」

Maybe he even found that new dream he had longed for so deeply.

「"A writer."」

And worked towards that dream.

[Announcement of the Winner of the 24th Rookie of the Year Award. Winning Work: 'The Origin of Memory'. Author: Lee Hakhyun]

At times, he would have hit the limits of reality and fallen into despair.

「"I'm sorry, Writer. As you know, the print book market isn't doing well these days..."」

「"How about writing a web novel? These days, that's..."」

But he never abandoned that dream.

「"Writer, you can't write like this. Did you even read the dialogue you wrote out loud?"」

「"Um... do you think I can really make a living by writing?"」

As a reward for not giving up on his dream, he faced the man from his dreams.

「"You look like a web novel writer."」

Finally, he reached the origins of his lost self.

「"Editor. I might have an idea."」

「"What is the title of this new work?"」

「"It's 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』."」

Han Sooyoung read and re-read his stories that were infrequently cut off.

He is the one who refused to be reborn as Kim Dokja.

The one who helped his comrades recover his lost memories.

That man, once a 'reader' who had forgotten this story,

「"I also want to have my own story."」

had returned to the story as a 'writer'.

Han Sooyoung held his hand for a long time.

"Wake up."

His limp body swayed helplessly.

"You didn't come here to die."

It was not a wound that could be healed.

"After everything you went through, you left to live the life you wanted."

Why did he have to come back here again?

Han Sooyoung did not know the answer. Perhaps Lee Hakhyun himself would have to find it.

Instead, Han Sooyoung recalled all the sentences she knew of 'Ways of Survival' and 'Omniscient Reader'.

However, no matter how much she thought about it, there was no way to heal his wounds in this world now.

After taking a light breath, Han Sooyoung lifted her head. Like someone searching for stars in the night sky, she stared into the darkness for a long moment, then slipped her hand into her coat.

Tsutsutsutsutsutsutsu.

[The Star Stream is watching you.]

[Some nebulae are watching your actions.]

[Some constellations are wary of your actions!]

[The Administration Bureau is determining the 「Probability Conformity」 of your actions!]

The channel fluctuated violently, and the approach of a probability aftermath could be felt.

In the Star Stream, saving someone requires far more probability than killing someone. Moreover, if death is already certain, there's no need to say more.

Moments later, a small pill was held in Han Sooyoung's hand.

The Life and Death Pill.

It was the ultimate medicine created by Lee Seolhwa, and an item that did not yet exist in this world.

She hadn't expected to use the emergency medicine she had brought along just in case here.

[Many constellations doubt the existence of the item you took out.]

[The Bureau prepares for scenario intervention!]

If she used this item, a probability aftermath would inevitably strike her.

Because it was an item that should not exist in this world.

"This wasn't the [Avatar] meant to be sacrificed here, but..."

Han Sooyoung pushed the Life and Death Pill into Lee Hakhyun's mouth. Along with the cozy warmth, soon his whole body was dyed with a soft light.

There was something she wanted to ask.

But now she had no time. With white sparks, her avatar faded little by little. The aftermath of probability began to roll in.

At the last moment, she squeezed the lemon candy in Lee Hakhyun's hand and said.

"Tell him that I received it well."

---

Soft snowflakes brushed against my cheeks.

When I opened my eyes to a pure white sky, I immediately realized where I was.

「Kim Dokja!」

As I jumped up and shouted, a familiar voice answered from behind me.

「I'm here.」

In the middle of the snowy field, Kim Dokja was crouched down, reading something.

Ways of Survival? Or had someone written a new novel in the meantime?

The moment that thought crossed my mind, I felt like I wanted to die.

「The lemon candy.」

"Sorry, I couldn't keep my promise."

Kim Dokja laughed wordlessly.

I looked around with a feeling of embarrassment.

But I couldn't help it. My pride as a writer was also hurt.

「How was Han Sooyoung?」

I thought for a while and replied.

「She was strong.」

Kim Dokja fought against such a Han Sooyoung several times. After fighting again and again, they eventually became friends.

「And, she was an excellent writer.」

Feeling a bit relieved, I added a word.

「Honestly, it felt like that worldline would be fine even without me.」

The theater dungeon had been cleared, and my role was finished.

That 'Han Sooyoung' wouldn't insist on the same ending after witnessing my death.

If it's her, she would find a way somehow.

An ending that won't seal Yoo Joonghyuk or sacrifice the readers.

A method I couldn’t find, she would find.

「Han Sooyoung doesn’t seem to think so.」

Huh?

I wondered what that meant. Was it the fatigue? My head wasn't working properly.

「Because this is your story.」

My story.

I suddenly felt dizzy.

「I’m just an extra villain. All I've done this whole time is incite myself to be someone other than myself.」

Throughout the scenarios, I became Kim Dokja again and again, and Yoo Joonghyuk as well. I forced my way through the scenarios like that, and in the end, I died.

Perhaps, it's because I wasn't the real Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk.

「You are Lee Hakhyun.」

I don't know why, but the moment I heard those words, I felt like crying.

「As well as Cheon Inho.」

「...」

「The name isn't important. What matters is that you were telling your story there.」

It felt like I'd heard something similar before.

But I couldn’t remember who had said it to me.

My consciousness slowly began to fade.

Maybe because I was about to die.

Struggling against sleepiness, I asked Kim Dokja.

「You...」

I wanted to ask him something, but I didn't know what. There were too many I wanted to ask.

Weren't you tired?

Enduring that long scenario, that story, all those years... didn’t you ever want to give up?

Why didn't you go back to your party members yet?

Kim Dokja opened his mouth.

「There’s a spell I recite when I’m struggling.」

I knew what the spell was.

We spoke at the same time.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

The name is not important.

For a moment, I felt like I could understand what he was saying.

In the first place, hadn't we endured life by borrowing each other's stories over and over again?

「I tried that too, but it didn’t really make me become Yoo Joonghyuk.」

「That's right.」

I couldn't forget the look on Kim Dokja's face as he said those words and nodded.

「But after saying that, I felt a little more like Kim Dokja.」

With a dizzying pain radiating through my entire body, I snapped my eyes open.

It felt like I should use that phrase I'd just heard.

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."

No incite was used. Even so, I felt a little energized.

Breathing out and raising my upper body, I saw the roof of the theater dungeon in ruins.

I felt a faint magical power swirling near my heart. New flesh had sprouted on my chest, where a hole had clearly been pierced, as if nothing had ever happened.

「I'm alive.」

I couldn't figure out how this could be possible.

Obviously, I fought with Han Sooyoung and died from being pierced through the chest.

The last sentence I wrote ended with my death. The scene was titled 'Death of the Villain,' making that outcome irreplaceable.

「Still, I was alive.」

Something slid down my shoulder with a gurgling sound.

The white coat Han Sooyoung had been wearing.

Holding onto the coat, I stood up and looked around.

I saw Yoo Joonghyuk and Jung Heewon lying unconscious. Their breathing was steady, so it didn’t seem like their injuries were serious.

Where did Han Sooyoung go?

The dawn was slowly breaking.

A meteor shower streaked across the sky's horizon.

It belatedly reminded me that this was the theater dungeon.

Kim Dokja and his companions must have seen that scene too.

The words of Kim Dokja, who had been watching the meteor shower with infinitely cold eyes, were finally felt through my skin.

「The scenario has just begun.」

I had already lost my life on only the third main scenario.

The chilling sensation of death was still vivid in front of me.

I was lucky enough to survive this time, but will I be able to do that again next time?

The scenarios to come were so terrifying that they could not even be compared to the theater dungeon.

Will the readers who came with me be able to endure all the trials and survive?

「Because this is your story.」

Can I protect them?

I pressed my hand to my forehead, trying to fend off the dizziness.

I could hear people's footsteps in the distance. After the scenario ended, the people who escaped from the movie were climbing up to the rooftop one by one.

Finally, the door on the roof burst open, and someone took the first step and asked me.

"Kim Dokja?"

I glanced around absentmindedly, but Kim Dokja was nowhere to be seen.

Understanding came a little too late.

Behind me, the strong backlight of dawn cast deep shadows across my face. My hand pressed against my face as a wave of dizziness washed over me, and I realized the exterior reinforced suit worn by the original Kim Dokja was still with me.

And the white coat clutched in my hand made everything clear. I knew what they had seen and how they had misunderstood.

I laughed and wanted to say I wasn’t Kim Dokja, but seeing the faces of people on the verge of collapse, every word inside me lost its strength and vanished.

People who read stories and loved stories.

They watched the stories of their favorite characters and endured life with joy or sorrow.

I heard people behind me asking the people who came through the door first.

"Hey, Kim Dokja?"

"Kim Dokja? Really?"

Desperate words from deep despair.

Beyond the door they opened, they hoped that there would be the Kim Dokja they were looking for.

「That moment. I understood Kim Dokja.」

The sound of a small meteorite falling in the distance was heard.

I quietly looked down at the coat Han Sooyoung had left behind.

「I am writer Lee Hakhyun and instigator Cheon Inho.」

Perhaps this is something only I can do.

['Thoughts of Almost Anything' transforms into 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit'.]

I quietly closed my eyes and recalled a man's face.

[The effect of 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit' is activated!]

A man who grinned at people with a blank face.

A person who wanted to see the epilogue of a novel while knowing the end of this world alone.

The protagonist of this story.

A white coat fluttered in the wind that blew over the building.

When I completely removed my hands from my face, the people who saw my face burst into tears.

"So he really, really existed."

"I told you! I knew he would be here!"

Just by confirming someone's existence, hope was blooming on people's faces.

"Kim Dokja!"

At one time, when I heard that name, one side of my chest hurt.

But now it wasn't like that.

「Still, this world needs Kim Dokja.」

I don't know if there really is Kim Dokja in this world or not.

「Nevertheless, this is still a story about Kim Dokja.」

Fortunately, lying is what I do best.

I smiled bitterly and waved at people.

「However, it is not a story about only one Kim Dokja.」

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 617 Episode 13 King (1)

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「A throne is still needed in a 'kingless world'. It is to let people know that there was a king there.」

—Mass-Production Type Maker

---

Exactly three days had passed since the incident in the Theater Dungeon. During those three days, the name that hit Chungmuro Station was as follows.

「"Kim Dokja!"」

Although some people just tilted their heads upon hearing his name. Some could not contain their joy.

「"Really? Is there really Kim Dokja here?"」

「"I lived. We're alive now."」

Of course, not everyone who remembered his name was happy.

「"Is he really Kim Dokja? Doesn't it just become more dangerous if we get entangled?"」

「"Would anything change if Kim Dokja appeared now? To be honest, we all know what Kim Dokja knows."」

Some people doubted the reality of the rumors, while others dismissed them as not a big deal.

However, whoever stood on either side, those who remembered 'Kim Dokja' would have thought of him and looked up at the sky for a moment.

「And with that, Lee Hakhyun thought it was enough.」

The roof of the theater dungeon.

After sighing lightly, I looked up at the sky, and the sun was setting.

Until all the scenarios were over, how many times did Kim Dokja look up at the sky?

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is looking at you.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is looking at you.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is looking at you.]

Watching the stars in the sky decrease, what did Kim Dokja think until the end?

"Inho-ssi."

When I looked back, Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu were waiting for me.

I nodded and asked.

"Is the dungeon cleanup over?"

"Yes. It seems there are no people left now."

Right after the theater dungeon ended, we cleaned up the acquired items and transported the injured readers to the bottom of the theater.

Kyung Sein added.

"There are no posters left, and the dungeon errors seem to be almost normalized."

There were some people who couldn't get out of the movie even after the dungeon was cleared, perhaps because of the probability aftermath that occurred on the roof of the

theater.

Fortunately, some readers, including Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu, actively cooperated with me, and after a few days of desperate struggle, we succeeded in rescuing all those trapped in the dungeon.

"How is the status of the 2 apostles?"

"Fortunately, Killer King fell asleep after eating 'The Spirit of Elaine Forest'."

Killer King, whom I had been worried about, was also in good shape. I sighed softly as I recalled Killer King fighting against the 'Lord of the Cretaceous Period'.

"Are you okay, Inho-ssi? You used more than ten pills of The Spirit of Elaine Forest this time..."

'The Spirit of Elaine Forest' was an item that cost 500 coins each. It wasn't a small expenditure for me either, but it was well worth the money spent saving the readers.

Anyway, this kind of expense comes back with sponsorship.

"Are you okay? Aren't you two hurt?"

"As you can see, I'm safe."

Kyung Sein gave strength to her small biceps.

Dansu-ahjussi asked.

"Is your friend okay?"

"Hey, what... I haven't done anything in particular."

Officially, I was known to have passed out and woke up in a corner of the rooftop garden.

Of course, it was officially said that it was, and unofficially, it was as follows.

「I became Kim Dokja for a while.」

I don't know why I did that.

But at that moment, I couldn't help but do it. Maybe not me, but anyone else.

There were people thrown into the perishing world, and there was a person they had been waiting for.

And only I knew the secrets of this world.

I had no choice but to lie.

Because I don't want them to give up on life. I'm not saying it's for anyone else's sake, but because I want them to continue to endure this hellish scenario with me.

I needed readers, and I wanted them to live on. That's all.

"Did you find anything on the roof? I heard that the battle was here."

Currently, it is known that there was a confrontation between Kim Dokja, Yoo Joonghyuk, Jung Heewon, and the owner of the theater in the 'theater dungeon' around Chungmuro Station.

"Yeah, well... nothing special."

It was fortunate for me.

It was because my head hurt to explain the things I met and fought with Han Sooyoung here one by one.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' asks what the hell happened.]

[Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' asks if anyone has secured the video.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks what the dokkaebi was doing.]

It seemed the constellations were unable to properly grasp the situation, perhaps due to the influence of the probability aftermath that swept the rooftop at the time. To think that no one had really seen that great battle, I felt a bit regretful.

It was a clash with 'Han Sooyoung', not another person.

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier smiles lightly.]

You never know.

Has anyone seen this guy?

"Really… Was Kim Dokja here? Did you see him, Inho-ssi?"

I inadvertently looked back at the place where I fought with Han Sooyoung.

Thinking back, it was a dizzying battle.

I was defeated by her sword, and pierced through the heart.

I definitely remember dying there.

When I woke up again, I was lying on the roof with my wounds fully healed.

Perhaps Han Sooyoung brought me back to life.

Why did she treat me?

And where did she go?

"Inho-ssi?"

I could feel the eyes of two people looking at me behind my back.

Wouldn't it be nice for these people to be sluggish?

In fact, there was no Kim Dokja here. Being here was just that.

"Yes, I saw him too."

I looked back at the two of them with a grin.

「Obviously, Kim Dokja was there.」

Honesty isn't always a good thing. We often have to let go of life with lies. Maybe that's why you read the story.

Suddenly, I felt like I knew a little bit why Han Sooyoung brought me back to life.

"Come down."

I walked with my hands on the shoulders of the two of them. I looked back to where I had been standing for the last time.

I really wish it had been you who was there.

---

Two blue eyes appeared from the pitch-black darkness of space.

【They are here.】

Starting with him, other eyes appeared all over the universe.

Red or blue, eyes engraved with a story of their own. A majesty that swept from beyond the void permeated every one of those eyes.

The pupils were all looking at one world.

The worldline they had watched for a long time.

It was the forgotten 41st world, and the last 'blank space' allowed to be modified by the 'Final Wall'.

【Those who saw the Oldest Dream.】

An electric sound was heard from the other side of the universe. The light of thought resounding in a place where there is no medium.

The nameless ones howled in pain, and the enraged deities of the other world roared with hateful rage.

The Outer Gods representing all the abandoned things in the world were speaking.

【Kim Dokja’s Company.】

The universe vibrated ominously. The Outer Gods' eyes turned to Earth. The far-off stories in their gazes engulfed the entire galaxy.

【Calm down. It is not yet time for you to move.】

Someone interrupted them.

A being wearing a white coat was holding back the pressure of the Outer Gods on behalf of Earth.

【Are you going to ruin the final chapter?】

It was Representative Kim Dokja.

The Outer God who recognized him spoke in true voice.

【You promised.】

【Kim Dokja’s Company should not exist here.】

Then, Representative Kim Dokja shook his head.

【I am the one who called <Kim Dokja’s Company> here.】

As if he couldn't understand the words, the intensity of the story bent once again in the space.

Even in the midst of suffocating sparks, Representative Kim Dokja continued with a calm expression.

【This story can only be completed without them, did you forget? As long as they exist, the universe you want will never arrive.】

For the first time, the momentum of the Outer God slowed down at his remarks.

【They will all die here. Along with the Oldest Dream they loved.】

Representative Kim Dokja, with a sweet smile, continued speaking while appeasing the Outer God.

【So please wait a bit. The final chapter will be prepared for you soon.】

The eyes of the Outer Gods trembled slightly, and one by one, they closed their heavy eyelids.

The turbulence of the stories, which had shaken under the gazes oppressing the Earth, calmed down little by little.

The moment the eyes closed for the last time, a voice as deep as the deep sea resounded.

【The unrecorded story will watch over you.】

---

As soon as I went down to Chungmuro Station, a message appeared in front of my eyes.

[Main Scenario #3 - Emergency defense battle has ended.]

[You got 2,000 coins as a reward.]

I had forgotten about the 'emergency defense battle'. The third scenario, which was about to end early due to the 'venomous fog' that had been sprayed.

[You have made a decisive contribution to the 'emergency defense battle'.]

[You got an additional 2,000 coins as a reward.]

[Your first story related to this scenario is germinating.]

First story.

I saw the message last time, but I was nervous.

This is because it was very important what one could gain from a birth story in this world.

Kim Dokja's first story was 'The King of a Kingless World'.

What is my first story?

When I checked the message log, there were a lot of unread messages piled up.

[The progress of the main scenario is being delayed due to the aftermath of probability.]

[The fourth main scenario will be announced in an hour.]

[Currently, there are 48 unread messages.]

From scenario delay messages to indirect messages from various constellations.

Anyway, it seems that the aftermath of the probability that blew into the rooftop garden was great.

It's to the extent that the progress of the 'main scenario' is delayed.

If that were the case, the Administration Bureau would have been talking about it—but no, it wasn't just the Administration Bureau.

[The Nebula <Tamra> is paying attention to you.]

I laughed bitterly inwardly.

I don't know if I should like this kind of message or be anxious.

"Wow, Inho-ssi. Now..."

Kyung Sein gasped. Apparently, the message was public.

"As expected, Inho-ssi went to the final floor, so it must be different. Ahjussi and I couldn’t go that far…"

She said, "What floor did he say you went to?"

"The 7th floor."

In fact, the 7th floor was also a great result. That's because it's almost as if it's been uploaded.

Wait a second. By the way, what was on the 7th floor?

"Did you go into 'that movie' by any chance?"

Kyung Sein, who knew what the movie was about, nodded as if she had been waiting.

"Yeah! Inho-ssi should have seen it too! Being summoned! Load! Launch! Ku Kwa Kwa Kwah! Two-quake-quake-quawa!"

How can you describe the legendary Battle of Myeongnyang in that way?

Aside from Kyung Sein’s vocabulary, honestly, I was a little envious seeing her in front of me.

"It must not have been easy to convince Lee Jihye."

"Ah, that's right. Ahjussi and I worked hard to encourage her. You know what Kim Dokja did."

"You did that?"

From what I remember, I don't think Kim Dokja did 'encourage' Lee Jihye. Rather, didn't he awaken her in a very dangerous way?

Perhaps conscious of my gaze, Kyung Sein smiled and looked back at me.

"Hee hee, I didn't do it exactly, but you... My words didn't work."

It was as if I had a vague idea of what had happened.

Dansu-ahjussi might have thought of his daughter Jiyoon while looking at Lee Jihye.

"I didn't say anything. I stayed by her side until she regained her heart."

"Ah, you said a word."

"That…"

Dansu-ahjussi evaded her words as if he was embarrassed, and Kyung Sein cleared her throat and raised a solemn voice.

"It’s okay to live."

Dansu-ahjussi, who became contemplative, hurriedly added words.

"Anyone could say that!"

What anyone can say.

But there is also a person who lives without ever hearing what anyone can say.

Maybe Lee Jihye was similar.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' pays favor to the incarnation.]

It seems that the role of the ahjussis is quite important in this world line.

I had a hunch.

It was then that a small monster came running with a light barking sound from afar.

We reflexively tried to pull out a sword, but when we realized the guy's true identity, we were delighted.

"Oh, Max."

It was the landlord's rat, Max, whom I had saved in the emergency defense battle not too long ago.

It must have become friendly with humans in three days. Max played around us, sticking out its tongue.

[Constellation 'Dog Who Threw Himself into the Flames' nods to the loyalty of the landlord.]

As I carefully stroked the rat's head, I saw a boy waving at me from across the turnstile.

"Everyone is here."

The 7th apostle, Ye Hyunwoo, was waiting for us.

"Is the dungeon cleanup over?"

"Yes, it is over."

"This side has just been cleaned up. All the injured have been moved downstairs."

Ye Hyunwoo took turns looking at me and my party for a while before opening his mouth.

"Inho-ssi, let's talk for a moment…"

After asking for the understanding of the party for a while, I followed Ye Hyunwoo.

The place Ye Hyunwoo headed to was an unexpected place. The simple sign indicating gender felt somehow unfamiliar. I was reminded of the fact that the civilization I knew had been destroyed.

"I didn't know you could still use the bathroom."

"Yes. Electricity comes on. Water comes out. It's like nothing has happened yet when I'm here."

The toilet of the destroyed world.

I didn't really feel the need to urinate, so I stood there for a while, staring at the bathroom mirror.

All I can see is Cheon Inho's face, pretending to be calm, narrowing his eyes, but since I'm still looking at this face, it seems like it's worth looking at.

Ye Hyunwoo, standing next to me, asked while washing his hands.

"Are the constellations looking at the bathroom too?"

"It's written."

Restroom. A place where you can do your business out of sight, wash your hands, and groom yourself.

[Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says that he is a constellation who knows manners.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' says he won't stop looking.]

[Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' warns everyone to leave the channel.]

Perhaps, such 'privacy' does not exist for mankind anymore.

I realized what the characters in this world are dealing with.

Now, the word 'alone' does not exist.

"I heard that Kim Dokja appeared."

A natural voice, like turning off the faucet in the bathroom.

I answered a beat late.

"Ah yes."

"He suddenly appeared on the roof of the dungeon and gave people instructions. Thanks to those instructions, quite a few readers survived."

"Yeah, I heard that too."

"Aren't you curious?"

"What do you mean?"

Suddenly, the boy's face reflected in the mirror seemed as unfamiliar as the symbol of the toilet.

For a moment, I wondered how much I knew Ye Hyunwoo.

I don't know who he really is. Whether he is a man or a woman, how old he is, what he has been doing.

No, maybe all that information is meaningless.

"None of the survivors of 'Theatre Dungeon' saw Kim Dokja go up to the roof."

I recalled one after another the tragedies that took place in the 'Theatre Dungeon'.

I thought of the readers pointing their swords at each other, and the Misreadings Association who killed people without hesitation.

Before entering the 'Theatre Dungeon', I had some trust in the 7th apostle, Ye Hyunwoo.

"Kim Dokja appeared 'suddenly', as if he literally fell from the sky. You know what's even more amazing?"

Then what about now?

Is Ye Hyunwoo still a trustworthy person?

Ye Hyunwoo, lightly wiping off his hands, looked in the mirror and said,

"Even the constellations in the sky don't know exactly what happened on the rooftop."

For a moment, I felt a chill.

How could Ye Hyunwoo, who is just an incarnation, already know the public opinion of the constellations?

"Inho-ssi."

Beyond the mirror, Ye Hyunwoo's eyes were looking at me. At that moment, I felt the presence of several people in the compartment inside the bathroom.

The moment I sang 'Thought' in my head, Ye Hyunwoo asked me.

"Are you 'Kim Dokja' by any chance?"

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 618 Episode 13 King (2)

"Are you Kim Dokja?"

I repeated Ye Hyunwoo's question in my mind.

Well, it wouldn't have been hard to notice if it was someone as smart as Ye Hyunwoo.

Ye Hyunwoo probably thought the following.

「There is a possibility that another incarnation pretended to be Kim Dokja. In other words, in the same way as Representative Kim Dokja.」

Ye Hyunwoo pointed me out as the culprit.

"I'm not sure what you mean."

I shrugged. Just in case, I was preparing [Incite] at any time, but unexpectedly, Ye Hyunwoo did not use [Lie Detection].

"Is that so."

Rather, he merely nodded his head with a calm face.

At the moment when I was wondering about the laxity that was not like Ye Hyunwoo, I heard a creak from inside the bathroom.

"Look at that, I didn't say that."

With a familiar voice, a man with a smoking pipe appeared. Almost at the same time, the door to the next compartment opened, and the woman with the iron rod also poked her head out.

"It's strange. I said that he was my direct attendant."

I feel like I hear that intuition every time.

"What are you talking about? I'm the one who guessed that the Secretive Plotter is Yoo Joonghyuk from another regression."

"At first, you said it was the Kim Dokja of the future. Do you think I forgot how you subtly changed it?"

The two people conversing were readers who had cleared the theater dungeon with me.

The old man with the smoking pipe and the woman with the iron rod.

According to my memory, the old man with the smoking pipe had read the entire 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 six times, and the woman with the iron rod had read it eight times.

Ye Hyunwoo said with a smile as if he was in trouble.

"I'm sorry. The two said they wanted to see Inho-ssi separately, so the old man with the smoking pipe stepped forward first."

"Nice to meet you. My name is Kim Kyungsik. Do you remember I sent you a message before?"

"I remember, but you spoke differently then."

This old man had sent me a message from the theater dungeon lobby.

Apparently, he had used honorifics at the time.

At my words, Kim Kyungsik scratched the back of his head and added,

"Ah, I’m an old man here, so I’m talking like an old man."

Something doesn't seem normal.

The woman with the iron rod, who pushed Kim Kyungsik aside, also introduced herself.

"I'm Goo Seonah. Of course, it's not my real name, but the name I'm using here."

A simple self-introduction. She was someone who somehow reminded me of Jung Heewon.

"Nice to meet you. I'm Cheon Inho."

"Cheon Inho? Wow, that ruined character has become so strong?"

Ruined character.

Goo Seonah let out a light sigh, and she said.

"As expected, I should have recruited you in the Theater, but it's a pity. You were the only one of us to make it to the rooftop, right?"

"I did, but I didn't catch the boss."

"Who caught the boss? You? The Kim Dokja you said you saw? Or..."

"Well, I passed out right away so I couldn’t see it well."

"Really? You're not lying?"

Perhaps showing signs of being persistent, Ye Hyunwoo intervened with good timing.

"Seonah-ssi, don't make things too difficult for Inho-ssi. He's not the kind of person who would lie."

"Please understand, Inho-ssi. She is just a bit mischievous..."

Goo Seonah frowned and said.

"No, I said I asked something great. It is possible to share information with the same Apostolic Society, right?"

Same apostolic society.

Apparently, these two, like Ye Hyunwoo, were also members of the 'Seven Apostles'.

Anyway, I also suddenly became a member of the apostolic society. At first, I used Dohee's secret phrase to fool Ye Hyunwoo, so now I can't say no.

Ye Hyunwoo sighed lightly and said.

"Sharing information is good, but that's not what brought you all here in advance."

After all, even if they got off the Chungmuro platform, they could say hello as much as they liked.

The reason why this place was created in advance must be that there was another intention.

"Is the next scenario delayed?"

"Eh. That's right."

I thought so.

Ye Hyunwoo looked back at me, Kim Kyungsik, and Goo Seonah and asked.

"Everyone should know the contents of the fourth scenario."

"Isn't it capture the flag?"

If a cataclysm did not occur in the main scenario, the contents of the next scenario were fixed.

'Capture the Flag'.

The prelude to a full-fledged group competition leading to a war to steal each other's stations and flags at each subway station in Seoul.

Ye Hyunwoo opened his mouth again.

"Those who are sitting here now are the strongest readers in the Chungmuro area."

I looked at Kim Kyungsik and Goo Seonah once again.

Both of them were hiding their powers, but at first glance, they seemed to have higher overall abilities than Dansu-ahjussi or Kyung Sein.

Goo Seonah asked.

"There must be some incarnations who are stronger than us, right?"

"As you know, in this world intelligence is also part of combat power."

"Are you looking at the long term?"

"You're right."

Readers right now rather than the characters. Even if they were weak, in the end, they had no choice but to become stronger by overeating their talent.

In addition, they survived until the third scenario and their ability to survive was verified.

Among them, the four with the most powerful abilities.

"Let's choose a representative among us?"

At Goo Seonah’s words, Ye Hyunwoo nodded his head.

"Yes. Exactly."

The reason why they brought up this story in a place where there are no characters.

"I will elect a king."

Ye Hyunwoo was thinking of electing the leader of the readers now.

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To begin with, we have not been able to reach an amicable agreement. There were many reasons, but Goo Seonah's answer was the most effective.

"You know that when you become a representative, you can force other members, right?"

"I do."

"Even if it's the same Apostolic Society, it's a little uncomfortable to entrust someone else to be the representative. To be honest, we don't know each other well, do we? We're not enemies, but we're not trusting each other and entrusting our lives to each other."

Even if I ask other readers, it seemed that they would give a similar answer as Goo Seonah.

To sum it up, it feels like this.

I want to be the representative.

"We just compete fairly, right? As long as we don’t harm each other, if we become the representative of the role in any way, we should recognize that person…"

Surprisingly, Ye Hyunwoo obediently understood the words, and we descended to the platform in heavy silence.

It's already such a war of nerves. I'm sure the fourth scenario won't be easy.

Around the time I put the platform in front of my eyes, Ye Hyunwoo, who was walking side by side with me, spoke to me in a low voice.

"Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"You said you weren’t Kim Dokja earlier."

Suddenly, I wanted to say something, but Ye Hyunwoo was smiling incomprehensibly.

"I hope you're not Kim Dokja."

My heart sank coldly.

As expected, Ye Hyunwoo seemed almost convinced that it was me who appeared on the roof.

I replied with a cheeky smile.

"Of course. I'm definitely not Kim Dokja."

Ye Hyunwoo looked at me like that and said.

"You sound like the real Kim Dokja."

"Ah, I’m Cheon Inho. I’m too villainous to be the main character."

"That's right. You have to do that in the future. Otherwise... I'm going to be in trouble too."

Getting into trouble?

I was about to ask what that meant again, but I met eyes with Literature Girl 64, who was carrying the meat from a few steps away.

"Ah."

She looked at me with her characteristic cool gaze, and she asked.

"Are you not hurt?"

LiteraryGirl64.

The reader who read my novel, Lee Hakhyun's short story.

Looking at her with the trace of a sword cut on her cheek from her arduous battle, I felt like I could understand why Han Sooyoung had searched so desperately for Kim Dokja.

If Literature Girl 64 is in danger, I will save her at all costs.

Because she was proof that I once survived as 'Lee Hakhyun'.

"Thanks. How is Killer King?"

"Seeing him talking in his sleep, I think he'll wake up soon. More than that... the atmosphere has changed a bit."

"Yes?"

LiteraryGirl64, who had been looking at my face for a long time, shook her head and passed by.

"Is it an illusion?"

What has changed?

Maybe my face is a little more handsome?

I looked into my face on the subway screen door.

Suddenly, my head throbbed, and strange memories came to my mind.

「When I take selfies in the bathroom sometimes, I don't think I have an ugly face...」

What?

That wasn't the sentence I was thinking of.

I stood blankly in front of the screen door and groped for my face. It was clearly the usual narrow-eyed Cheon Inho.

However… Do I really think he's a little handsome? Is it because of the mood?

"I heard that the scenario will come out soon?"

As I passed by, I heard the voices of the incarnations talking.

"What scenario?"

"They're going to pick a station representative."

Rumors about the scenario seemed to have spread.

[20 minutes left until the start of the main scenario.]

As soon as he returned to Chungmuro Station, Ye Hyunwoo called people to the center of the platform.

About 100 people survived at Chungmuro Station.

I checked the number of 'readers' who had survived by using [List of Reader Comments] on each of them.

A total of twelve readers remained.

The number is much smaller than what we saw in the lobby of the Theater Dungeon.

There was no need to ask what would have happened to readers who were not here.

"Inho-ssi."

Kyung Sein and Dansu-ssi also had sad expressions, probably noticing that fact.

"Do not worry. It will be fine."

What is okay?

If I die here, I will become a Kim Dokja kkoma, so is it okay to be taken to the Bureau by Representative Kim Dokja?

You two will support me no matter what.

I didn't even know what I was talking about, I thought while holding the shoulders of the two of them.

I will definitely protect these people no matter what.

"We will start an emergency meeting from now on."

Ye Hyunwoo immediately proceeded with the story. The content itself was straightforward.

"Until now, everyone had a lot of trouble completing the scenario. In the future, we will enter into a full-fledged collective survival. And for that, it is first necessary to determine the representative of this district."

Ye Hyunwoo, who continued to speak with dazzling eloquence, took a moment to catch his breath, looked around him, and suddenly changed the tone of his voice.

"But before we talk about it in earnest, I have something to confess to you all."

I realized who he was looking at. He was looking at the 'readers'.

[Incarnation 'Ye Hyunwoo' activates 'Lie Detection'.]

"I am an apostle."

Some readers caught their breath at the unexpected declaration.

But most of the incarnations who don't know what apostle means had puzzled faces.

"What?"

"I mean I know the future of this world."

['Lie Detection' confirms that the statement is true.]

The sudden remark made the crowd silent for an instant.

"Uh, what does that mean?"

"Do you know the future?"

Ye Hyunwoo replied.

"Those of you who have been with me since the beginning of the scenarios will know how I did it."

Some incarnations nodded. All of them were members of the building owners association who had been through the Chungmuro Station scenario with Ye Hyunwoo.

"Certainly, Hyunwoo was special. As soon as the scenario started, he also caught bugs."

"That's right. Even in the second scenario, if Hyunwoo wasn't there, everyone would have died. Isn't that right, elder?"

Then Gong Pildu, who was petting Max at the center of the platform, spoke.

"Hyunwoo did a great job. He certainly knows information about the future."

People looked at each other and whispered. How on earth does that boy know the future, what the hell is an apostle, and so on.

It was exactly the confusion Ye Hyunwoo intended.

Ye Hyunwoo gave a calm voice to the people who were embarrassed.

"The reason I know the future is simple. I read the 'Revelation'."

"The Revelation?"

"The Book of Revelation is a book that contains the story of this world."

[Lie Detection confirms that statement is true.]

As if dismissing people's confusion, Ye Hyunwoo went all the way to the heart of the platform.

"I've been thinking for a long time whether or not I should share this information. But I guess I should clarify now."

I noticed Ye Hyunwoo's design.

Now, this world is the 41st turn of 'Ways of Survival'.

This was a completely different world from the 'Omniscient Reader' we know.

The world was twisted because of the readers, and some scenarios were twisted at the cost of the twist.

It was more difficult than the 3rd round.

That's why Ye Hyunwoo thought.

「I can no longer watch innocent people die.」

He decided to recreate the method used by the villains and prophets.

"I will share all the information I know of 'The Book of Revelation' and save all of you. I will definitely protect you no matter what."

[Lie Detection confirms that the statement is true.]

Revealing the existence of the 'Apostles' to the world and informing the world of the existence of the Book of Revelation.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is shocked by the existence of the Book of Revelation.]

[The constellation 'the two-legged expert' doubts that there really is such a record.]

[The constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' feels heavy.]

[The constellation 'King Heulmu' makes an interested expression.]

[The constellation 'The Last Hero of Hwangsanbeol' says that something has come.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' informs the Star Stream of this fact.]

[The Bureau begins discussing the Probability Fit Decision.]

With this, the constellations that had lost interest and chattered about now would become interested in the story of this peninsula again.

With this, this world would become a little closer to the 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 we know.

"Let me introduce myself again. My name is Ye Hyunwoo. I am a person who has read the 'Revelation' 50 times and remembers almost everything in the 'Revelation'."

And in this new 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 world, the role Ye Hyunwoo wanted was clear.

[The 'representative election' will begin in one minute.]

Ye Hyunwoo was looking at me from afar.

I hope you are still not Kim Dokja.

Now I understand why he said that.

"I want to be the representative of Chungmuro Station."

Now he is trying to become the Kim Dokja of this world.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 619 Episode 13 King (3)

Suddenly, I recalled the day when I boldly started my first web novel.

My first work was 『The Orc Philosopher』.

At the time, editor Ji Eunyu said after reading my novel:

「"Let’s leave aside the fact that the main character is an orc for now."」

Being an orc is a dislike. Check.

「"I'll leave aside being a philosopher."」

Philosophers have problems too. Check.

「"The important thing starts here. The protagonist created by the writer is too inflexible."」

「"He’s not flexible?"」

「"Look at episode 2 here. As soon as he starts, he foolishly deals with a crisis that he can avoid without getting hit in the back of the head."」

I asked again while re-reading the sentence I had written.

「"But all the other novels also started with a blow to the back of the head?"」

「"If you get hit in the back of the head, you have to get up right away. Awaken, regress, or possess! But what if he doesn't do anything? What if he just keeps on despairing? We have to show unconventional development."」

「"This protagonist is a schoolboy. Isn't schooling originally started out of despair?"」

「"And here is episode 6. Same thing. The main character is trying too hard."」

「"It's good to work hard, right?"」

「"If you go this far, there should be a reward."」

「"It's only been 30 years since then..."」

「"The average hero works 30 years and gets something!"」

「"He has come to the realization that there are things that can't be done even after 30 years."」

Ji Eunyu ignored my words and pointed out the next episode.

「"And here, episode 15 is also a problem."」

「"There is a scene in which the main character saves the weak... Can’t this be done?"」

「"It's okay to save the weak, but if you helped the weak, the main character must also be rewarded. The main character also helped because he knew that implicitly. But look! Right now, the author's main character saves the weak, but is only misunderstood and pointed at!"」

I thought for a moment and asked.

「"Does it matter?"」

「"It’s important!"」

「"If you help in hopes of getting something in return, you're not really helping, right?"」

Ji Eunyu looked at me curiously, and she replied:

「"But this is the 'normal protagonist's' way."」

「"Shouldn't the main character be normal?"」

「"There was a time when an extraordinary protagonist was the norm. The boys' cartoons of the 90's were like that. A noble and sublime protagonist. Protecting the weak, fighting against villains, deeply despairing, sometimes being captured and losing everything. Look at the other works these days. Are there many protagonists like that?"」

I thought.

Certainly, Ji Eunyu seemed to be right.

「"Times have changed. Even if the genre is a delusion, it is a story that is one step further into the realm of reality."」

Ji Eunyu continued as she looked down at the mixed coffee from the tearoom.

「"Readers now prefer ordinary people to become heroes. Because they can identify with them. A protagonist who carries out their petty daily revenges for them. A protagonist who isn't frustrating, has the right amount of flexibility, and is rewarded for his efforts. A protagonist who knows how to get a proper reward. Most people can't even do that right."」

Now that I think about it, maybe it wasn't just about a novel.

It was because Ji Eunyu's expression, as she said that, looked strangely tired.

「"If you just listen to the story, it seems that you are just a calculating person rather than a main character."」

「"Even if it is calculated, where does anyone do good things? In today's world, that's enough to qualify you as a main character."」

Ji Eunyu's advice, like ready-made mixed coffee, had a sweet but bitter aftertaste.

「"It's the writer's job to make the misunderstood main character look likeable."」

The reason why the conversation at that time came to mind was probably because of the question Ye Hyunwoo received in front of him.

"I know you're talented. But do you really deserve to represent us?"

Ye Hyunwoo answered people's aggressive remarks without losing.

"There is no such thing as qualifications. But if you acknowledge it, a qualification will be created."

Ye Hyunwoo, who said that, was looking at the 'readers'.

He is talking to us - to me now.

He asked to be chosen as the protagonist of this stage.

「Is Ye Hyunwoo qualified to be the main character?」

I recalled the qualifications of the 'main character' listed by Ji Eunyu.

1. Awaken, regress, or possess.

Ye Hyunwoo was possessed.

2. Be flexible.

His flexibility is overwhelming no matter how I look at it.

3. Be prudent.

Ye Hyunwoo did not seem like a person who would make a losing trade.

You can tell just by looking at him that he demanded a 'new age' in exchange for hiding my secret.

4. Move for the weak and get paid.

Ye Hyunwoo definitely moved for the weak.

Even in the 'emergency defense battle', without Ye Hyunwoo, there would surely be a greater loss of life.

Is he all there is? Even Ye Hyunwoo declared in front of everyone that he would protect everyone while using [Lie Detection].

He won't have [Incite] like I do, so the declaration must be genuine.

In return, he became a leading candidate for Chungmuro.

Up to this point, he had satisfied all the conditions of a protagonist these days that Ji Eunyu said.

Besides, there must be a piece of Kim Dokja inside him.

There was no reason why he couldn't become the 'Kim Dokja' of this story.

But why?

A corner of my heart continued to ache.

[The 'representative election' will begin in 30 seconds.]

It was then that Dansu-ahjussi grabbed my collar.

"Inho-ssi, Hyunwoo-ssi can't. That kid is Jiyoon's friend."

Ahjussi's daughter, Jiyoon, was not yet an adult. She's probably a high school student.

If you were a friend of such a child, Ye Hyunwoo would also be a teenager.

Thinking like that made Ye Hyunwoo even more amazing.

A boy in his teens survived this far on his own and was challenging the representative of 'Chungmuro Station'.

However, just because the boy's ability is outstanding, am I willing to entrust the heavy burden to him?

[The Administration Bureau withdraws the probability suitability decision.]

Just in time, the administration also expressed its intention.

[The Administration Bureau determines that there is no major problem with the probability of its existence.]

Suddenly, Kim Dokja's words came to mind.

That age and gender don't matter in this world.

But is it really okay? Is it really okay for this world to be like 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』?

"Don't worry, ahjussi."

I opened my mouth as if reassuring Dansu ahjussi.

"I won't let him do so."

It wasn't because I didn't trust Ye Hyunwoo.

The boy will keep his promises, and he will keep people safe.

The problem was then.

All enemies coming forward will aim for Ye Hyunwoo's life. Just as Kim Dokja in the main story made so many sacrifices.

[The constellation 'Red Mountain Army' is glaring at the incarnation 'Ye Hyunwoo'.]

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail' snorts at 'Ye Hyunwoo's' remarks.]

[Very few constellations think that the incarnation 'Ye Hyunwoo' is arrogant.]

Maybe it had already started.

A group of people who are hostile to Ye Hyunwoo.

Constellations of the Misreading Association and nearby historical-grade constellations were baring their teeth at him.

Ye Hyunwoo's complexion turned slightly pale at the threats coming from everywhere, but he did not back down.

[Incarnation 'Ye Hyunwoo' activates 'Lie Detection'.]

Rather, he took a step further toward the center of Chungmuro Station and made a deal.

"For those who first agree to me becoming the representative, I will give that kind of benefit. And to those who do not agree with me becoming the representative—"

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

"There will be absolutely no disadvantages. I will protect everyone here no matter what."

Ye Hyunwoo would know.

If he makes a mistake here, he could die.

He could be hated by the constellations and betrayed by people.

However, Ye Hyunwoo did not give in and took courage.

It is probably because he read Kim Dokja’s story as hard as he did.

[Sub Scenario - 'Representative Election' begins.]

But he still doesn't feel it properly.

This world is no longer the 'Omniscient Reader' he knew.

**<Sub Scenario: Election of representatives>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: C

Clear condition: Occupy the 'white flag' installed in the center of the platform.

Time limit: 30 minutes.

Reward: 1,000 coins

Failure: —

* The representative of the station can exercise strong control over all members.

Along with the message, a 'white flag' appeared in the center of Chungmuro Station.

Up to that point, the development was the same as in the main story.

"Hey, it really showed up!"

The problem with the people who were surprised was the message that followed.

[If the flag's owner is not changed 5 minutes after the flag is acquired, Chungmuro Station will come under the control of the flag owner.]

['Capturing the flag' changes the owner and resets the 5 minutes timer.]

['Capturing the flag' is recognized by killing the owner of the flag.]

For a moment, even my heart was thrilled.

A message that was not in the main story was added.

'Capture the flag is recognized by killing the owner of the flag'?

Of course, the location of the flag was right next to Ye Hyunwoo.

Ye Hyunwoo stretched out his trembling hand and said.

"If there is no objection, I will take it."

If you see a message like that, you might be intimidated enough, but Ye Hyunwoo was indeed determined. Probably because he has nowhere to back down.

"If you touch that now, we are enemies now."

As expected, the woman with the iron rod—Goo Seonah, came forward. Next to her was Kim Kyungsik, the old man with the smoking pipe.

"We haven't agreed to you being the representative yet."

They judged in an instant. At this rate, Ye Hyunwoo will become the representative of Chungmuro Station.

I just wanted to block that.

"Others, please say something!"

The people led by Goo Seonah and Kim Kyungsik also helped. Kim Kyungsik, who took a sip of his smoke pipe, opened his mouth.

"I heard your speech. But you left out an important part. That you are not the only one who is an 'apostle'."

Kim Kyungsik's words once again threw the hall into confusion.

"There may be friends I don’t know well yet, but there is not one 'apostle' in this world. Even if a few people like that boy know the future, there are more than a dozen of them. And I am one of them."

[Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' opens his mouth.]

[Constellation 'Heungmu the Great' asks if that is really possible.]

Kim Kyungsik continued to speak without missing the timing when the incarnations were agitated.

"I know that Ye Hyunwoo has excellent qualities. But you are especially young among us. How can you become the representative of a group with a short social experience?"

For the first time, Ye Hyunwoo made an angry face when he talked about his age.

"Elderly people, I don’t think the original age is too much."

"Hum. What are you talking about? I'm on the younger side of my mental age, but I'm older than you."

"There's no law that says you're wiser just because you're older. And the important skill in this world is how well you can remember and use 'Revelation'."

"I also read Revelation six times—"

"Only six times."

Kim Kyungsik's face turned red.

"I've read it fifty times."

To that number once again, some readers exclaimed.

Certainly, fifty is an insane number.

You could say it's crazy to read a single novel 50 times, but it's a novel that reaches 551 chapters in its entirety.

"Wait, if it's the order of reading a lot..."

It was then that the reaction of readers became strange. A few people's eyes moved slowly towards us.

Something came to mind later.

Come to think of it, among them, there were those who saw the confrontation between the uploaders of the Misreading Association and me from the 'theater dungeon'.

Kyung Sein, seizing the opportunity, raised her hand.

"Hey, if the number of times you read the Book of Revelation is the condition for being a representative, then I have something to say."

"Kyung Sein, you are not on the level to be here."

In response to Ye Hyunwoo's unusually cold voice, Kyung Sein nodded and replied.

"Yes. But that's not what I'm talking about."

"So?"

Kyung Sein hesitated and continued talking.

"As far as I know, there are people here who have read the book of Revelation over a hundred times."

"What nonsense are you talking about?"

Ye Hyunwoo had a strangely angry tone.

Well, according to the information obtained so far, for the apostles, the number of complete readings was their pride.

Perhaps the standard for ranking the 7 apostles is the number of times the story has been read.

"I've read the book of Revelation 50 times. People who have read more than me are—"

"There are a few, you know."

Officially, the 7th Apostle, Ye Hyunwoo, is a first-class member of the Apostolic Society.

It meant that there were six people who had read all the novel more than him.

"There is, but not here."

Among them, only the 2nd Apostle Killer King is at Chungmuro Station now.

However, Killer King is in a state of rest after eating the 'The Spirit of Elaine Forest'.

"But there is one person here."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

"Who the hell?"

Then, Kyung Sein took a fancy pose and pointed at me with both hands.

Suddenly receiving everyone's attention, I lightly bowed to those around us with an awkward smile on my face.

Ye Hyunwoo looked at me in disbelief.

"Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"Is that statement true?"

There's no need to lie here.

I nodded.

"Please answer honestly. Inho-ssi, how many times have you read the 'Revelation'?"

[Incarnation 'Ye Hyunwoo' is activating 'Lie Detection'.]

"That’s a hundred times—"

At my words, Ye Hyunwoo laughed.

"You must be kidding. No matter how much you read, I can’t believe that much..."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is false.]

Ye Hyunwoo looked at me as if to see that.

I continued, trailing off.

"More than a hundred times. One hundred and ten times? One hundred and twenty? To be honest, I’m not sure because I didn’t count."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that the statement is true.]

Ye Hyunwoo’s expression hardened.

A heavy silence swept through Chungmuro.

He was silent, partly because he did not understand what I meant, and partly because he understood what I meant.

The first to speak was the group in the back.

"That rumor... was it true?"

"Is there really a madman who has read it over a hundred times?"

Several readers who already knew the number of times I had read the book trembled, and Goo Seonah and Kim Kyungsik also shook their heads.

"He's not Kim Dokja, but I'm sure he's just as insane as Kim Dokja."

"It's a strange number of times to hear it again. But did Kim Dokja read 'Ways of Survival' that many times?"

Ye Hyunwoo, who had maintained his composure from beginning to end, could not hide his agitation this time.

He opened his mouth in a trembling voice.

"There is only one person in this world who has officially read the Book of Revelation more than a hundred times. Inho-ssi, maybe you..."

For the first time, faint agitation was shown in Ye Hyunwoo's eyes.

"The head of the Apostolic Society... Are you the 'First Apostle'?"

It seems that this is the start of an unwanted illusion.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 620 Episode 13 King (4)

"Inho-ssi, please tell me. Are you the 'First Apostle'?"

There were a total of two of the 'Seven Apostles' that I had seen so far.

The 2nd Apostle Killer King who finished reading ORV 100 times.

The 7th Ye Hyunwoo who finished reading it 50 times.

Killer King showed tremendous growth along with his sister, Literature Girl 64, and signed a contract with the Archangel 'Jophiel', while Ye Hyunwoo quickly conquered Chungmuro Station by utilizing Gong Pildu.

If these two were already at this level, what kind of person was the First Apostle?

Looking at the expressions of Ye Hyunwoo and the other apostles, they seemed to have no idea who the 'First Apostle' was.

The person who had read the novel at least a hundred times and created the community known as the '7 Apostles'.

Who has been reading this story with readers from places I don't know.

At first glance, someone's face came to mind, but I shook my head.

No way. No, that person.

How did they accept my silence? The apostles who exchanged glances in the meantime began to express their own opinions.

It was Ye Hyunwoo who lit the fire first.

"Even if... even if you say you are the 'First Apostle', I can’t give in this time. In the first place, the Apostolic Society is not a ranking system."

Goo Seonah frowned and said.

"Hey, didn't you say earlier that we should decide the representative based on the number of readings?"

"I didn't say that."

"Huh? Stop. As soon as you hold the flag, we will attack."

Goo Seonah, holding her iron rod, and Kim Kyungsik, holding his smoking pipe, approached the flag.

A distance that everyone can reach in one step if they set their minds to it.

In the fiercely heated atmosphere, Ye Hyunwoo sighed.

"In the end, let's decide by force."

The atmosphere was on the verge of an immediate battle.

But why?

Even in the suffocating confrontation at the risk of each other's lives, Ye Hyunwoo, Goo Seonah, and Kim Kyungsik seemed strangely excited.

It wasn't just them.

Kyung Sein and other readers were also making the same faces.

It wasn't hard to figure out why.

[Many constellations are looking forward to a bloody battle in Chungmuro Station!]

[Some constellations start betting coins!]

[A very small number of constellations declare that they will sponsor 1,000 coins to incarnations who refrain from serving as Chungmuro's representative.]

It was because the constellations began to take an interest in this place.

So far, the constellations had not properly understood the story of Chungmuro Station.

An important theater dungeon: the relay of the battle was canceled due to a 'probability aftermath', and as readers talked about information related to 'Omniscient Reader' without even trying, all the constellations had to listen to the conversation intertwined with filtering.

The constellations must have been similar, as few readers would be interested in a story they couldn't quite understand.

"It was like that a little while ago."

Now readers were fighting with each other, but at the same time they were collaborating.

With the word 'Revelation' as the cornerstone, the readers visualized the fight in this world in earnest.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' says that he finally understands what they're talking about.]

[The constellation 'Great King Heungmu' wonders where 'The Book of Revelation' came from.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says he has a clue.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' says to talk.]

To create a narrative for the constellations, using as much unfiltered terms as possible.

Claiming to be an apostle, making his existence known to the world, and arousing the interest of the Star Stream.

[A very small number of constellations announce the outbreak of the 'Apostle War'.]

At the center of this edition, created by the power of pure readers, even I was a little thrilled.

「This was a story they hadn't read yet.」

A new stage of the original work, created by readers, but everyone here knew this was a play, but in the end, everything on the stage becomes reality.

"Inho-ssi."

I nodded at the voice of Dansu ahjussi.

"I know."

If this is the case, people will die.

Goo Seonah's iron rod appeared, and white smoke rose from Kim Kyungsik's smoking pipe.

Ye Hyunwoo, whose expression hardened, slowly raised his right hand.

It wasn't just them.

Other incarnations were also stealthily reaching for weapons.

[Some constellations avow the danger of 'apostles'.]

[A handful of constellations watch the bloody battle in Chungmuro Station.]

[A very small number of constellations want them to destroy themselves by fighting each other.]

The stars watching this story now wished for their destruction.

Just as readers once watched these stories, so now the constellations watch their stories.

Still, I wasn't worried.

Because there was something to believe.

"All ready for battle."

With Goo Seonah's declaration, nearby incarnations grabbed their weapons at once.

An imminent situation in which a battle seems to be about to break out at any moment.

A roar erupted from one corner of the station, accompanied by the sound of something exploding.

「He’s here.」

I thought he would come by now.

There's no way he, not another guy, will ignore this important scenario.

"Everyone back off!"

The moment Gong Pildu, surprised, jumped up from his seat, a man in a black coat appeared.

I smiled and looked at the owner of that coat. However.

"How dare you choose the 'representative'?"

There was something strange about the way he spoke.

"It's because you didn't invite Killer King to a place like this."

A sloppy black coat blew in the wind.

Judging by his energetic expression, it seemed that the wounds he had sustained in the Theater Dungeon had completely recovered.

Kyung Sein, who was very excited about the appearance of the new face, whispered.

"Inho-ssi, were you waiting for the 2nd apostle?"

I shook my head.

Killer King ambled through the crowd, then slowed briefly as he passed me.

"Thanks to you, I lived. I will pay off the debt."

Killer King lightly put his hand on my shoulder. At first glance, you'd think it was the real Yoo Joonghyuk.

Behind Killer King, I could see Literature Girl 64 sighing while holding her forehead.

Literature Girl 64, who found me, asked.

"Are you okay?"

"That's what I want to ask."

"It's okay if it's my brother."

Killer King is strong.

But no matter how strong Killer King is, will he be able to deal with Ye Hyunwoo, who has joined Gong Pildu?

"Shut up, Killer King."

Ye Hyunwoo warned Killer King, who was approaching without hesitation.

"What if I don't like it?"

"I'll shoot."

"Then shoot."

Killer King smiled and added.

"You were talking about the number of readings before, but try talking again."

Ye Hyunwoo bit his lip at Killer King's provocation.

If you think about it, Ye Hyunwoo felt like he was holding Killer King in check from the first time he met him.

"You don't deserve to be here. You only played solo from the beginning. A guy who has never saved a person will shamelessly represent us?"

"I also saved people. Do you think it would have been possible to clear the scenario if I hadn't gone up to the Theater Dungeon?"

"It's not like you cleared it."

"Thanks to me, one guy went up to the roof, so it's the same as if I cleared it."

"What nonsense—"

"If I can't do it, then you and the other apostles are not qualified. And Chungmuro Station should have a fixed owner, so why are you greedy?"

The original owner of Chungmuro Station.

Needless to say, he was referring to 'Kim Dokja'.

Ye Hyunwoo shook his head and said.

"There is no Kim Dokja here. I heard that he was found on the roof, so I searched for him, but I couldn't find him no matter how much I searched. Now, one of us has to become 'representative'."

"There is no Kim Dokja..."

Killer King looked at me for a moment and then turned his head.

"Then I guess I should be the representative."

"Ahjussi, Armed Zone!"

[Incarnation 'Gong Pildu's' 'Armed Zone Lv. 6' is activated!]

Gong Pildu's stigma [Armed Zone] does not activate without [Private Land].

In other words, in preparation for this battle, Ye Hyunwoo said that he had made the area into a [Private Land] in advance.

Killer King laughed coldly.

"Hyunwoo-yah, can you handle it?"

Unusual magic flowed from Killer King's body. Just by checking the amount of magic power, I was able to detect a change in Killer King.

He’s got a chance.

On the 4th floor of the 'Theater Dungeon', Killer King fought against the 6th grade Earth Dragon on behalf of me and Literature Girl 64.

When we found the stunned Killer King again, it was after the monster that was attacking him had disappeared somewhere.

It was unknown whether Killer King had defeated the Earth Dragon or not. What is certain, however, is that he has grown even further there.

A red aura rose from Killer King's body, which was blessed by Jophiel.

"They don't really look at you. You know it's different from fighting over comments, right?"

Without being weighed down in the slightest by Killer King, Ye Hyunwoo stood next to Gong Pildu. [Mini Turrets] rose all at once and aimed at Killer King's body.

"This is what I'm talking about."

It was a battle that could not be easily predicted. The combination of Ye Hyunwoo and Gong Pildu's turrets, an almost invincible synergy in the beginning of the scenarios.

And Killer King too. The incarnation of 'Jophiel', a legendary warrior.

I called out to Literature Girl 64.

"Yerin."

"Yes."

"What do you think?"

Even though it was a question without an object, Literature Girl 64 answered right away.

"My brother is strong."

The same answer as always.

But that wasn't all of the answer.

"But you are a strong man by yourself."

I too had the same thought.

No matter how you look at it, Killer King didn't jump there because he wanted to be a real representative.

He just wants to stop the 'Apostles' from going to war.

And he is, foolishly, a man who does not know how to deal with anything other than that.

"Could you help me?"

"How?"

"It will just take a little bit of time."

I have no intention of killing anyone here.

I quickly explained the strategy to Literature Girl 64.

"I'll give you 5 trillion. Go away."

With Ye Hyunwoo's warning, Gong Pildu's [mini turret] started loading.

"Everybody get out of the way! Attack before the load runs out!"

Goo Seonah and Kim Kyungsik ran toward the flag.

The moment when Killer King—who had given a rough blow—joined the front line, Literature Girl 64 knocked down Killer King from behind and fell to the floor.

"Go."

I nodded and ran straight to the flag.

After Killer King was taken away, there was no one with higher agility than me right now. Goo Seonah, who spotted me, opened her eyes wide.

"What—"

I used [Incite] to activate 'Thoughts of Almost Everything'.

Goo Seonah screamed and fell over at the quick strike of the thoughts.

"Sein-ssi."

At about the same time, I threw the shield on my back to Kyung Sein.

"This, this?"

It was the 'Shield of Hercules', although it is a replica.

Kyung Sein, who brightened, immediately put on the shield and followed me.

[The special skill 'wide area defense' is activated!]

Soon after, a translucent barrier spread around the shield.

The incarnations that rushed in were blocked by the barrier and screamed.

"What, what!"

Dansu ahjussi didn't stand still either. The cockroaches that had been wandering around the station in Chungmuro began to scatter and disturb the vision of the incarnations.

"Waaaagh! What!"

In an instant, the whole area became a mess, and Ye Hyunwoo and the other apostles were greatly embarrassed.

"Inho-ssi, I must have warned you."

Ye Hyunwoo's cold eyes were looking at me.

"Shoot at him. Don't let him get close to the flag."

As if he had made up his mind, Gong Pildu's [mini turret] opened fire on us.

With each hit, the translucent barrier began to crack.

Kyung Sein became contemplative and shouted.

"Inho-ssi! It's breaking!"

I could have died here if I hadn't scanned the shield beforehand.

I used [Incite] to transform the shape of [Thoughts of Almost Everything] into [Shield of Hercules].

[The special skill 'wide area defense' is activated!]

Despite activating two layers of wide-area defenses, the firepower of the [Mini Turret] was formidable.

As soon as the first barrier collapsed, Kyung Sein looked back at me.

"Inho-ssi! Hurry up!"

The second barrier also began to crack.

I glanced around to see the white flag blowing in the wind.

A distance that can be reached with just a hand.

If I hold this flag and hold on for five minutes, Chungmuro Station will be mine.

Perhaps, Kim Dokja would have done that.

「I must not hold this flag.」

But why? I kept thinking like that.

「That's not the 'correct development' of this story.」

It was at that time that whitish tobacco smoke flowed in through the cracked defenses. In an instant, the smoke took on a human form and reached out toward the flag.

The old man with the smoking pipe, Kim Kyungsik.

"Sorry, but I'll take this."

I never thought he had the [Smoke Human] skill.

The moment Kim Kyungsik's hand almost touched the flag, one side of the defense wall broke and someone burst in.

"Hey!"

Kim Kyungsik, whose stomach was kicked, rolled on the floor helplessly. He didn't even have time to recover, and the wind blew his hair back as he was swept away by a blast.

"Heewon-ssi."

"I'm late. I'm sorry."

It seemed that the wounds of the Theater Dungeon had not yet healed, and Jung Heewon's complexion was not good. However, I had to borrow the hand of the wounded now.

"Please."

"Leave this to me."

Jung Heewon blocked the gap, and Dansu ahjussi, who approached us with his mouth closed, also helped her.

Me, Jung Heewon, Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi.

The four of us each stood guarding the north, south, east and west sides of the white flag.

Kyung Sein asked in a nervous voice.

"Inho-ssi, didn’t you want to have the flag?"

"No. If we take this, it will become a real war."

Ye Hyunwoo was shooting cannonballs, and the apostles were also wielding weapons, but they weren't serious yet.

Because we haven't gotten our hands on the 'white flag' yet.

But if you hold the flag, the 5 minutes timer runs from then on.

Goo Seonah and Kim Kyungsik, who have been watching all the time, will also attack with all their might.

Ye Hyunwoo and Gong Pildu will also pour more powerful shells.

'No matter how strong we are, we can’t deal with the entire Chungmuro Station with just four people.'

"Inho-ssi, I can’t—"

In the end, Kyung Sein, who was in charge of the main course, also reached her limit. A shell that flew through a gap in the defense wall hit Kyung Sein's shield directly. With a loud sound, Kyung Sein's knee broke.

I supported her and bit my lip.

It’s about time.

With this level of commotion, no matter where he is in Chungmuro Station, there's no way he hasn't heard it.

So-so-so-so!

Finally, the wide-area defenses collapsed and shells started pouring in.

The moment Kyung Sein screamed and raised her shield, a thick, dark shadow blocked their path.

Tuquaang!

A man, who seemed to be two or three times as big as her, stood in front of her, blocking the shells.

"Are you okay?"

A strong and honest voice.

Among the readers here, there was no one who did not know his name. Because he was a member of Kim Dokja's company, and he was the shield Kim Dokja trusted more than anyone else.

"Do not worry. You're safe now."

Steel Sword Emperor Lee Hyunsung looked back at us with a smile.

And that wasn't all.

"Mister. Don't overdo it."

Maritime Admiral Lee Jihye.

Next, standing next to Jung Heewon was a man with white hair.

"There, woman. You look strong, shall we fight later?"

Delusion Demon Kim Namwoon.

Ye Hyunwoo, who was surprised by the sudden appearance of the trio, also stopped shooting.

"What…"

And somewhere I heard footsteps.

The only one person in this world.

For a moment, I felt like I could understand Kim Dokja's feelings. The reason Kim Dokja had no choice but to overcome his life by repeating his name at every juncture in his life.

「There is an incarnation that can fight the entire 'Chungmuro Station'.」

In the distance, the group of avatars could be seen parting.

They weren't really overpowered, but people ran away or collapsed in their seats like gazelles encountering a beast.

It had to be.

The feeling that flowed from the body of the approaching man was simply because the strength was different.

「"The protagonist created by the author is too inflexible."」

Perhaps Ji Eunyu was right.

Clearly, such characters are not popular.

It's so unpopular that only one person in the world has read the whole story about him.

Look at him.

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier is watching your story.]

Maybe, he is still reading it.

「A man who foolishly copes with avoidable crises.」

「A man who is constantly in despair.」

「A man who has rolled through decades to arrive at an answer that it is 'impossible'.」

The character I wanted to write so much was probably already in this world. After going through hundreds of betrayals, despair, and realizations; the reason Ye Hyunwoo, who satisfied all the conditions of being a protagonist, could not become the protagonist was simple.

「This is because a 'protagonist' already exists in this story.」

He walked silently through Chungmuro Station, where silence fell.

Ye Hyunwoo, Goo Seonah, Kim Kyungsik, and even Killer King held their breath and stiffened.

Jung Heewon was the only one who glared at him with her head held high.

I didn't move, holding onto her collar tightly just in case.

While no one dared to open their mouth, Yoo Joonghyuk passed me leisurely through the forked road.

Standing quietly in front of the flag as if reaching his throne, Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at the flag for a long time with his hands in his pockets.

At that moment, everyone in the station realized. If someone had held that flag, they would have been decapitated by Yoo Joonghyuk’s great spear here.

Looking at the 'white flag' that no one was taking, Yoo Joonghyuk's bright eyes slowly turned to me.

"This is mine."

It was the main character's words.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 621 Episode 13 King (5)

No one dared to object to Yoo Joonghyuk’s declaration.

That was only natural; the moment they raised an objection, they would find their necks on the line.

Both incarnations who knew Yoo Joonghyuk and incarnations who did not knew him could only accept it.

With this, the owner of Chungmuro Station was decided.

Some incarnations trembled, and I saw readers making complicated expressions.

A few frightened people whispered.

"Is this okay?"

"But if it's Yoo Joonghyuk..."

"It's a problem because it's that Yoo Joonghyuk."

I seemed to know what they were thinking.

—Were you aiming for this from the beginning?

Ye Hyunwoo was glaring at me from a distance of ten steps away.

Instead of making a fuss, I spoke to the crowd.

"A new representative has been elected. Let's all celebrate."

Clap clap clap.

As my shameless applause echoed through the station, everyone looked at me as if I were a madman.

I looked around.

Goo Seonah and Kim Kyungsik also glared at me.

Everyone wondered why I didn't take the 'white flag' and waited until Yoo Joonghyuk came.

It was written all over their faces.

「At this point, Yoo Joonghyuk is the most suitable representative for Chungmuro Station.」

I calmly endured the gaze of the readers and kept the future of Chungmuro Station in my head.

「If Yoo Joonghyuk becomes the representative, it is not impossible for him to bring Chungmuro's readers together.」

Yoo Joonghyuk is the main character of 'Ways of Survival' and currently the strongest incarnation.

If Yoo Joonghyuk was the representative and no one else, readers would not be able to vote against it.

「This was the 'Chungmuro Consolidation Operation' planned by Lee Hakhyun.」

What is my role there?

"Come on, take the flag."

What is it?

"Everyone is waiting."

I could see some readers frowning at my brash tone.

But I can't help it. Right now this is the best choice.

Didn't I tell you?

Originally, my first survival plan was to stick close to Yoo Joonghyuk and then transfer to Kim Dokja.

I didn't think it would happen like this...

"My mind has changed."

It was then that Yoo Joonghyuk said something strange.

"Yes?"

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was looking at me blankly, instead of holding the white flag, pushed it over with his foot.

The flag rolled right to my feet. Yoo Joonghyuk, who looked down at the flag for a moment, said to me:

"Take it."

---

"Inho-ssi. What happened?"

Things got weird. For the confused readers, here's a summary of the situation in Kyung Sein's version:

1. The main character Yoo Joonghyuk appears cool and claims that the flag is his. (possible)

2. The main character, Yoo Joonghyuk, looks around the station with a look of agony. (can be)

3. The main character Yoo Joonghyuk passes the flag to the suspicious Cheon Inho (???) ⋘ New!

Jung Heewon asked curiously.

"Did you give that person money?"

"He’s not the type to do this for money."

Yoo Joonghyuk walked away, stepping on the flag he had knocked over, and sat on a bench far away, staring at me.

It seemed like he would wait and see what choice I would make.

[The constellation 'Cavalier Commander' admires incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk's' spirit!]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks what the hell incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk' is doing.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' purses his lips while looking at incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' asks what the hell is going on.]

I wanted to ask too.

Why did this happen?

"But touching it with your feet doesn't seem to qualify for ownership. Shall I touch it for a bit?"

"Sein is also right. Then, what are you going to do when you become a representative?"

"Hehe."

While Kyung Sein and Dansoo ahjussi were hanging out across the flag, I looked down at the fallen flag and lost myself in thought.

「If it were the Yoo Joonghyuk I knew, he would never leave the flag to someone else.」

The moment a 'flag' is owned, everyone in the station becomes a group member of the flag's owner.

Nevertheless, instead of taking the flag himself, Yoo Joonghyuk handed it over to me.

Why?

There are two hypotheses.

One hypothesis: Yoo Joonghyuk has regressed.

The guy suffering from regression depression has gone mad, so he surrendered the flag to me and made a showdown to come in as my roommate.

No matter how much I thought about it, I couldn't afford it.

Just looking at those splendid eyes, he is extremely sane.

Hypothesis 2: He noticed that I was using him for the apostles' fight.

But even if he found out about it, there was no reason for Yoo Joonghyuk to hand over the flag to me.

In the first place, if it's Yoo Joonghyuk's personality, it's not even a matter of caring about one or two apostles.

Seeing that I was being watched by an obsessive guy, I suddenly remembered what had happened in the theater dungeon.

「"You are Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Wait a minute, maybe?

The third hypothesis, 'Yoo Joonghyuk who repaid the favor', appeared.

I assisted Yoo Joonghyuk in the 'theater dungeon'.

My [Incite] woke up Yoo Joonghyuk, who fell into 'regressive depression', and Yoo Joonghyuk took the opportunity to defeat the boss of the theater dungeon (it can be said that it is entirely thanks to me).

So, is this also the third hypothesis?

But, is 'Yoo Joonghyuk' who repaid the favor a story that exists in this world?

If it was possible, I wanted to go to the snowfield and ask Kim Dokja.

"Excuse me."

"What are you going to do?"

The incarnations cautiously raised their hands and asked me.

I haven't officially taken the flag yet.

Ye Hyunwoo, Goo Seonah, Kim Kyungsik, and even Killer King and LiteraryGirl64.

Suddenly, all the incarnations of Chungmuro Station were looking at me.

「Yoo Joonghyuk entrusted the disposal of this flag to me.」

I don't know why he gave me this flag.

However, it was me from now on who decided who owned this flag.

---

[The representative of Chungmuro Station has been elected.]

Just as if the fight over the representative seat was a lie just a little while ago, the incarnations cooperated with each other to help fix the broken station.

"We have to use this place as a base for the time being. Seonah noona, please secure food for the people to eat. Kyungsik ssi will ask you to form a detached unit to scout nearby stations. Representatives for other stations will have been elected by now. There may be people from the Misreading Association."

“Leave it to me."

People moved in perfect order according to Ye Hyunwoo's words.

"And....."

Ye Hyunwoo, who met my eyes from afar, lowered his head subtly. It was still awkward.

Someone beside me spoke up.

"You really are a weirdo."

When he turned his head, he saw Gong Pildu with a disapproving face.

He was petting Max, a short-haired pup, and watching Ye Hyunwoo as he moved supplies.

"You could have been the representative. Hyunwoo wouldn't have had any complaints either."

"It's really annoying to do so."

"Why?"

Most of the incarnations here were members of the building owners association who had solved the scenario together with Ye Hyunwoo.

If I had been the representative, they would have complied reluctantly, but they would not have expressed their allegiance to me from the bottom of their hearts.

In fact, even when 'Kim Dokja' took over Chungmuro Station, there were some breakaways from this group.

And.

"Above all, they look very good together."

**[Currently, the representative of 'Chungmuro Station' is incarnation 'Gong Pildu'.]**

One of the Ten Evils, Armed Fortress Master Gong Pildu.

He is the backbone of Chungmuro Station and an incarnation with the power and personal connections to lead this station without being a 'reader'.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is disappointed with your protective behavior.]

[The constellation 'Heungmu the Great' asks if they're not fighting then.]

Several Constellations expressed dissatisfaction with my decision. I understand them.

Still, it wasn't a losing business from my point of view.

[The constellation who has not yet revealed their modifier is interested in your choice.]

[The constellation 'Flying Dragon' praises your judgment.]

[The constellations of absolute good admire your wisdom.]

[The constellation 'Master of Defense' supports your judgment.]

[2,000 coins have been sponsored.]

I continued stroking Max, who was rubbing against my calf.

"I gave it to him because Pildu agreed to my terms."

[You are not subject to Chungmuro Station.]

[Currently, you are not affiliated with 'Chungmuro Station'.]

The contents of the contract between me and Gong Pildu were simple.

I, the apostles, and those who refuse to be ruled by the representative are to not be placed under the control of Chungmuro Station and not forced to act.

Form a temporary alliance with me, but do not have enmity with our party until the end of the scenario.

Pledged all these issues with the 'Oath of Existence'.

[The 'Oath of Existence' has been activated.]

The Oath of Existence. An oath of an incarnation whose heart is burned with blue magic when the specified conditions are violated.

Readers who watched from afar were exchanging opinions.

"Seonah, are you really going to stay here?"

"What?"

"As long as the representative has no compulsory power, there is no rule that we cannot be together."

"Yeah, then I'll be in Chungmuro too."

What the apostles are afraid of now is that one representative wields 'unlimited power'. If that was the solution, there was nothing they couldn't cooperate with.

The reason readers couldn't come up with this simple answer was probably because they couldn't afford it.

Because they had been reading this story alone a while ago.

But the readers I knew were never the ones who read stories alone.

> strawberry1137: Didn’t I tell you before? Secretive Plotter is the protagonist! It's Yoo Joonghyuk from another world line! I thought so!
>
> barampoong: You said it was Kim Dokja before?
>
> killer_king: I'm Yoo Joonghyuk.
>
> Princemaker77: He always makes the same comments.

Reading the comments written by readers, I briefly reminisced about the old days.

"Please. Just like you protected Hyunwoo, please protect those people."

"I didn't protect Hyunwoo. Hyunwoo protected me. I'm just paying off the debt."

I already knew that Gong Pildu had a special regard for Ye Hyunwoo.

Because I knew that, I entrusted Gong Pildu with the burden of being the representative.

「This Gong Pildu was different from the Gong Pildu I used to know.」

I don't know what Ye Hyunwoo did to change Gong Pildu like that.

Did the setting value of 'goose father' evolve, or was he originally this kind of person but he didn't have any luck in the main story?

Either way, it was great.

In a sense, Ye Hyunwoo had accomplished something that no one else had ever done before.

"Are you leaving? You'd be safer here too."

Surely I'll be safe here for a while.

But.

"Yes."

There is one thing I realized after meeting Han Sooyoung in the theater dungeon.

To reach the end of the scenario in this 41st turn, it is not possible with ordinary determination.

If I just follow the path Kim Dokja walked, I will never survive when I meet her again.

"I must become strong. Perhaps, even more so than Kim Dokja from the 3rd turn."

"Tell me if you need help."

"I hope that never happens."

I saw Yoo Joonghyuk, who was sitting on the bench, get up from his seat.

It was time for him to leave.

---

I packed up with Jung Heewon, Dansoo ahjussi, and Kyung Sein and got ready to leave Chungmuro.

Some people came out to see us off. Among them, there was also LiteraryGirl64.

"What about Killer King?"

"He's in shock and won't get up."

"In shock? Why?"

"He’s looking up at the ceiling and muttering 'I was a fake'."

I seemed to know roughly what state he was in.

"Please comfort him."

LiteraryGirl64 nodded her head.

"We can meet again."

"Sure."

"We’ll talk a lot about novels again."

Lastly, I also exchanged greetings with Ye Hyunwoo. Seeing as he was still hesitant, I felt awkward.

There are people of that kind in the world. A person who commits more sorry things because he can't stand being sorry.

"If you're going to apologize, this is your last chance."

Fortunately, Ye Hyunwoo was still a boy, and he was not old enough to be reprimanded for not being familiar with various kinds of social etiquette.

"If you get hit by a shell, you usually die."

Ye Hyunwoo, his face reddened, lowered his head with his eyes wide open.

"Sorry. Sorry, Inho-ssi... I didn't mean to kill Inho-ssi. I couldn't think of a better way..."

I looked at Ye Hyunwoo for a while, then took out one of my items from my arms and set it down on the floor.

['Miniaturization' is deactivated.]

As the manuscript, which had grown in an instant, revealed its true form, Ye Hyunwoo's complexion changed.

"This is..."

"This is the 'new manuscript' you asked for back then."

Ye Hyunwoo opened his mouth as he inspected it.

"Really, really."

Judging by the twinkling of his eyes, Ye Hyunwoo is also a reader.

"But why give me this?"

I answered in a confident voice toward Ye Hyunwoo, who bowed his head.

"You did it to save people."

"Oh, no. I... I just—"

"Did you want to become Kim Dokja?"

Ye Hyunwoo's eyes suddenly turned round as he raised his head.

The expression of 'how did you know' was on his face.

I had no choice but to know.

['Readers' Comments List' is activated.]

> I don't know if the author will see it. I'll try it once though. There is a spell that I sometimes memorize when I am having a hard time. "I am Kim Dokja." But my friend said I look more like an octopus than a squid. I just wanted to say thank you. In a few days, I'll come back for a regular drive.
>
> —Recommended 351/ Disliked 0
>
> (Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 551)

I just couldn't help but know from the moment I saw it for the first time.

So I wanted to tell him.

"Hyunwoo-ssi is not Kim Dokja. He is strong enough and cool enough without being Kim Dokja."

Not everyone has to be unhappy.

This world is a story created by just one person's misfortune, not a story written for everyone to be unhappy.

"Don't become Kim Dokja. Don't sacrifice yourself for someone. Survive no matter what. By all means."

Sacrifice is not the only way to save someone.

Just a single word can save a person from the danger of death.

The readers have taught me this.

So now, this may be the author Lee Hakhyun's old reply to those days.

"But I also memorize that spell sometimes."

"Yes?"

"I am Kim Dokja. I don’t really want to become Kim Dokja, but when I say that, the things surrounding me just feel like a story."

I lightly patted Ye Hyunwoo on the shoulder, who had blank eyes, and turned away.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' nods.]

I saw a group of people waiting for me from afar.

A step later, I heard Ye Hyunwoo's voice calling me.

"Wait! Inho-ssi! You are -"

I am not Kim Dokja.

I know, the readers know, and Yoo Joonghyuk, who is walking ahead of me, knows.

Staring at the protagonist's handsome back of the head, I thought of my old readers.

[The fourth main scenario is in progress.]

[You are currently not affiliated with any station.]

Chungmuro, a solid castle built by Ye Hyunwoo and readers.

I thought of the high fortresses they had built and the empty thrones for the vanished kings.

There will be no king in Chungmuro now.

Strangely, though, I still had the feeling that someone in a white coat was sitting there.

[You have become a 'Wanderer'.]

[A hidden scenario has begun.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 622 Episode 14 Hunting (1)

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Yoo Joonghyuk strode ahead without hesitation. He didn't say where he was going.

Lee Hyunsung, Kim Namwoon, and Lee Jihye followed close behind, a step or two behind him.

We kept a certain distance and pursued Yoo Joonghyuk and his party.

How much time did we spend like that?

Kyung Sein, who was walking beside me, quietly raised a worried voice.

"Can we keep following him?"

"He didn't tell us to follow him. Instead of belonging to 'Chungmuro Station', we chose to become 'Wanderers'."

It was a risky decision, so before making this choice, I sought the opinions of Kyung Sein, Dansoo ahjussi, and Jung Heewon in advance.

—Chungmuro should be safe right now, but I think Inho-ssi will be the one who will save me when I am really in danger.

Kyung Sein.

—Can I go and look for Jiyoon?

Dansoo ahjussi.

—I think you'll die somewhere if left alone.

Lastly, Jung Heewon.

At this point, I thought that we might have been together in our previous lives.

"Thank you for the new sword, Inho-ssi. I'm sorry for the late thanks."

"Do you like it?"

Jung Heewon swung Mikazuki Munechika into the air.

"Very."

Even so, she did not take her eyes off the back of Yoo Joonghyuk's head.

Only Jung Heewon could still burn with fighting spirit even after witnessing Yoo Joonghyuk's power.

Excluding special cases like regressors or reincarnated people, the strongest among the ordinary people is probably Jung Heewon.

Right after leaving Chungmuro Station and coming completely to the surface, Yoo Joonghyuk stopped his steps.

He looked around the ruined city with cold eyes and brought his party to a halt.

"Wait."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who stuck his great spear into the ground, looked back and forth between the western and northern streets in contemplation.

West and north from this point.

Something vaguely came to mind, but there was not enough information to confirm it.

I wish I could find 'Ways of Survival'.

All I have now are comments from readers and memos that come to mind from time to time.

As we settled down at a distance, Kim Namwoon noticed us.

The moment the grinning guy was about to come this way, Lee Jihye let out a chilling voice.

"Don't pick a fight for no reason. Unless you want to get hurt by me."

"Huh? Yes."

The person who approached us instead of the hesitantly muttering Kim Namwoon was the most moderate and kind man in Yoo Joonghyuk's party.

"Hello, are you hurt?"

"Ah, no. Thanks."

"Sorry. Our captain tends to be quiet."

"No. We're following on our own."

Lee Hyunsung, with his honest eyes, smiled, showing off his strong chest muscles.

Looking at his naive expression, I realized once again that I had really entered Omniscient Reader.

The real 'Steel Sword Emperor' Lee Hyunsung.

I didn't have time to appreciate it because I was in the middle of the battle earlier, but seeing it this way made me thrilled.

Suddenly something came to my mind and I looked back at Jung Heewon.

However, Jung Heewon, who met Lee Hyunsung, did not seem to be particularly impressed.

What seemed strange was the other side.

"Sein, do you work out?"

"Yes? How did you know?"

"Your posture is clean. You seem to use a wide squat for the hold and a hammer curl for the upper block, is that correct?"

"Wow, you noticed!"

[Character 'Lee Hyunsung' feels favorable toward incarnation 'Kyung Sein'.]

Is this okay?

I looked back at Jung Heewon.

"Why?"

"It's nothing."

Well, if you think about it, there is no law saying that Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsung must be connected.

Because the 41st turn and the 3rd turn are different.

But, anyway, this...

[A constellation who likes to change genders is excited.]

I decided to just ignore it.

Now, the first step is to check the newly shown scenario.

**<Main Scenario #4 - Capture the Flag>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: C+

Clear conditions: (The window is hidden because there are many contents.)

Time limit: 14 days

Reward: 2,000 Coins

Failure: ???

As expected, the fourth scenario was a 'flag battle' like the main story. When I clicked the clear conditions, a window with a long description appeared.

**[Clear Conditions]**

1. Every station representative has a 'flag'.

*Flags can only be carried by station representatives.

2. When you capture another group's flag, you can steal all stations owned by that group. Conversely, when the 'flag' is captured, all stations owned are taken away.

3. Even if you fail to capture the flag, killing the station representative will count as a successful capture, and you will receive bonus points in this case.

A new rule has also been added.

You don't have to take the flag, just kill the representative, and it even gives bonus points.

I felt it during the 'theater dungeon' scenario as well, but there was a strange sense of incongruity in the scenarios of the 41st turn.

It felt as if someone had read the entire story and modified the scenario to suit their taste.

...But that was probably just overthinking.

4. There are hidden 'white flags' in some places on the surface.

Second new condition.

A white flag is also hidden outside the station.

It is probably the hidden piece of this scenario.

5. You must obtain the flag of the 'target station' within 14 days. Failure to do so will result in the death of all members of your group.

* Currently, your 'target station' does not exist. You are unable to perform that scenario.

The conditions for the last task were almost identical to those I remembered.

[Currently, you are a 'Wanderer' without a station.]

[You cannot participate in 'Capture the Flag'.]

[A hidden scenario has been imposed.]

I checked the 'Hidden Scenario' window that followed.

**<Hidden Scenario - Wanderer>**

Category: Hidden

Difficulty: C

Clear Condition: Join a new group or kill the group leader and capture their flag.

Time limit: 3 days

Reward: 'Capture the Flag' Scenario participation ticket.

Failure: ???

Wanderer Scenario.

It was a scenario that could be called a kind of wild card round for the defeated.

I called Dansoo ahjussi, Kyung Sein, and Jung Heewon and started talking.

"Did you all read the scenario?"

"Yes."

"For now, there are three possible options. The first is to go to another station and ask the representative to accept us."

In any case, it was not difficult to clear the scenario itself, since you can get away from the Wanderer's penalty by just finding a 'group'.

Kyung Sein shook her head.

"If that was the case, I would have just joined the Chungmuro group. What about the second one?"

"The second is to raid another station and capture the flag. And the third is…"

"Finding the hidden white flag. Right?"

"Yes. You're right."

"Then it must be the third, right? Usually the third is the correct answer."

It was. In the Omniscient Reader for 'Kim Dokja'. Kyung Sein, who had been watching quietly, asked in a whisper.

"Do you know the location of the hidden white flag? Just like Kim Dokja knew the location of the hidden 'Green Zone'."

It would be nice if things went smoothly like that.

"No, I don't know."

"Then what are you going to do?"

"We have to take the flag of another station."

In the end, no matter what, the 'flag fight' was a fight to hold each other's flag.

Confrontation is unavoidable, and we must take over other stations. Only then will the hidden scenario 'King's Road' be opened, and we will be able to gain the right to challenge the 'Absolute Throne' in the future.

Dansoo ahjussi spoke in a solemn voice.

"Looks like it's going to be a tough fight. I wish we could just capture a flag, but it won't be that easy."

The station whose flag is captured loses control to the station that captured it.

Even at Chungmuro Station, a fight broke out because of this, but in other stations, I wonder.

Jung Heewon also added:

"If I had to kill them anyway, I'd feel less guilty if they were people I didn't know well."

Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein were surprised at the murderous intent contained in her cold tone.

I said to comfort the two of them:

"It would be nice not to kill them if possible, but there will inevitably be situations where we can’t help it. Everyone, prepare your hearts."

Thinking of future fights, the battle we went through at Chungmuro Station was nothing more than child's play.

Our enemies will be more clever than Ye Hyunwoo, more inconsiderate than Han Sooyoung, and more brutal than Gong Pildu.

Just looking at the Misreading Association, whom I met a while ago, that is the case.

They were tenacious, immeasurable in number, and a group of criminals who did not abide by social common sense.

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' is smirking at you.]

An indirect message that was chilling to contemplate.

They were the Constellations of the Misreading Association.

[The constellation 'Rat That Spreads the Plague' tells you to try your best.]

I remembered that little mouse that Asmodeus used last time, and it seemed that bastard had crawled back in again.

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' warns you that even in death, you will never reach the ranks of the constellations.]

It was an unfair fight from the start.

The members of the Misreading Association could spy on us anytime during the channel broadcast and leak information to their incarnations.

After thinking for a while, I called Bihyung through 'Dokkaebi Communication'.

—Why. What is it.

"I have a favor to ask of you."

I enumerated the list of constellations from the Misreading Association that I had discovered so far, and asked Bihyung if he could track their position on the channel.

—Are you out of your mind? To constellations of our caliber! How dare an incarnation...!

"Listen. I understand that the channel's finances have weakened a lot recently. Is that correct?"

At the sudden financial talk, Bihyung swallowed his words for a moment.

—It’s none of your business.

"It's all because of sponsorship. The support amount must be much lower than before, right?"

—It was reduced, but... I'm also looking for the cause.

The channel's finances weakened because the apostles were all talking about filtered conversations.

It was because the constellations had escaped.

The stupid Bihyung didn't seem to know that fact yet.

"Have you looked at the list of constellations I mentioned? They probably don't have a record of sponsorship."

—Certainly they are the ones with no record of sponsorship.

Just as I thought.

"Shouldn't we start managing the quality of the channel soon?"

—Hmm. Well, it's not wrong, but it's a bit…

"Of course. You can't punish them for that reason. The only thing I'm worried about is... There are rumors that the Bureau's channel was recently breached."

—Where did you hear that again?

There were facts you could gather no matter where you listened.

"I don't think those guys entered through normal means."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 623 Episode 14 Hunting (2)

Oddly enough, I felt that way.

I was sure that the guys who committed illegal acts in real life would do something similar here.

—That can't be. How tight is the security of our Bureau...

Even as Bihyung said that, he seemed to notice that there was an uncomfortable corner somewhere.

—Stay still. I'll find out and return shortly.

Even after Bihyung disappeared, the provocations of the constellations of the Misreading Association continued.

[The constellation 'Rat That Spreads the Plague' says it's useless no matter how much bug-like humans struggle.]

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' says it's very amusing.]

[The constellation 'Rat That Spreads the Plague' says that the illegal stream is the best.]

Seeing the messages resounding loudly, Kyung Sein frowned.

"Those bastards."

"Never mind them."

Seeing them suddenly so noisy, I thought it would be safe for the time being.

In retrospect, the 'Rat That Spreads the Plague' was severely damaged by Asmodeus, and the 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' must have used too much probability to bestow protection on the '6th-grade lizardmen' in the theater dungeon.

In other words, there wasn't much room left for them anymore.

"The Snake That Cut Its Own Tail."

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' is glaring at you.]

"I heard that Killer King sent his regards. Did you receive them well?"

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' is exerting its status over you!]

Sparks faintly wrapped around my body.

Still, just hearing the threat of a constellation and an indirect message sent chills down my spine.

I would never have thought that this degree of probability would still remain in the 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail'.

It was the moment when I was suffocating little by little due to the pressure that was slowly rising.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' says that if they don't shut their mouths, he will rip them open.]

The message that flew through the air blew away the pressure as if it had been washed away.

It was indeed Cheok Jungyeong.

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' is flustered.]

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' warns him not to meddle in other people's business.]

Wait a second. Are you going against Cheok Jungyeong?

Are you crazy?

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' warns him not to mess with the grand status.]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' tells them to keep talking if they want to die.]

Or are those the eyes of someone who hasn't finished reading the novel yet?

[The constellation 'Rat That Spreads the Plague' sneers at the threat of 'Goryeo's First Sword'.]

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' is silent, claiming the old man has lost his mind.]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' warns them that if they say one more word, he will throw his sword.]

[The constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' tells him to cut it if he can.]

[The constellation 'Rat That Spreads the Plague' sneers, asking if he even knows where they live.]

Indeed. Maybe it was because they used to only write malicious comments in real life, but their aggro skills were excellent.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' scratches his ears, complaining that it is noisy.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' warns them to fight with their fists like men instead of barking.]

That's how the constellations in the channel frowned one by one, and the moment Cheok Jungyeong finally made a decision.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' draws his sword.]

A faint sound of electric sparks resounded in the sky, and the disappeared Bihyung returned.

[Please calm down, Constellations. I will adjust the channel settings for a moment.]

The guy who was gasping for breath seemed to be exhausted.

—You... How the hell did you know?

Bihyung, who revealed a translucent shape in the air, spoke to me in a disbelieving voice.

—These bastards, they are the ones who went through the illegal route created by the Six Beaks.

I knew that.

These guys were committing illegal things here too.

"So it seems. Are they going to be penalized?"

—A notice will come out from the Bureau soon. These bastards have been watching the channel without paying a single fee until now.

After a while, a system message was heard in the air.

[The Bureau's sanctions list has been updated.]

[The channel access of the constellation 'Snake That Cut Its Own Tail' has been temporarily restricted.]

[The channel access of the constellation 'Rat That Spreads the Plague' has been temporarily restricted.]

Apparently, there were other guys besides them who were subscribing to the channel illegally.

I admired the excellent and prompt action of the Bureau. It would have been nice if sanctions were done this quickly in real life.

—This time, the matter was serious, so the Bureau decided to add a tracking request. I'm going to hire a fixer to collect the fine.

"Who are you going to send?"

I didn't even have to ask.

It was because a message from the Bureau came straight away.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' has accepted the Bureau's request to be the cleaner.]

Misreading Association guys, you're going to have a hard time for a while.

It was then that Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been looking up into the sky, opened his mouth.

"Lee Jihye. Kim Namwoon."

It seems our protagonist has finally finished organizing his thoughts. The Misreading Association wasn't even there anymore; it was really good timing.

"Go to Myeongdong Station. When you arrive near Myeongdong Station, you will see a large cathedral. Retrieve the holy relic in the cathedral."

"Okay, Captain. What's the name of the relic?"

"You'll know when you see the Saint's Smile."

There was a memory that came to mind the moment I heard the name.

「The Saint's Smile. A holy relic found in Myeongdong Cathedral, containing the protection of an archangel. If you set Jung-gu as the early farming route, make sure to secure this relic first.」

It was strange.

This is an item that doesn't even appear in Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

Have I ever written a note like this?

Yoo Joonghyuk continued to speak.

"Lee Hyunsung, go southeast along the road to Seoul Tower. There is an empty lot at the top. Your mission is to retrieve the meteorite that fell there."

"Yes, I understand."

Meteorite that fell on Seoul Tower.

[Dark Iron, the material for the Dark Sky Demon Sword. Often found in the rainbow meteorite.]

As expected, the sentence came naturally this time too. I was nervous, but there was no time to think about the sentence.

It was because Yoo Joonghyuk immediately looked at our group.

"Dansoo."

He didn't expect him to remember his name, so he was a little surprised.

"You follow Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon."

"Come quickly, mister. If you're late, I'll leave you behind."

Dansoo ahjussi turned around as if asking if it was okay, so I silently nodded.

To maximize growth at the beginning of the scenario, splitting the party here was the right choice.

Moreover, if his companions were Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon, there was nothing to say.

"Please take good care of ahjussi."

At my words, Lee Jihye winked at me as if telling me to stop worrying.

Yoo Joonghyuk then looked at Kyung Sein.

"You."

"Yep!"

Kyung Sein, who was in high spirits as if she were a private soldier, stood upright.

"You move with Lee Hyunsung."

"All right!"

"Thank you, Sein-ssi."

"Me too! I really want to be like Hyunsung-ssi!"

"Yes? Like me? Why?"

Kyung Sein, who was next to Lee Hyunsung, laughed hysterically.

That person obviously had a favorite Jung Heewon, but what happened?

In any case, Yoo Joonghyuk's judgment of dividing the party was excellent.

Dansoo ahjussi has good application skills, but lacks actual combat experience with other people.

Putting Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon together, who are strong in interpersonal battles, must mean that he should watch and learn from them.

It was the same in the case of Kyung Sein. Kyung Sein had a natural physique and a good sense as a fighter, but she was not as quick to switch offense and defense like Lee Hyunsung.

It was clear.

The reason why the two were paired was that Yoo Joonghyuk highly praised Kyung Sein's growth potential.

Yoo Joonghyuk stepped forward one last time and looked back at Jung Heewon.

"The two of you, follow me."

---

After Dansoo ahjussi and Kyung Sein left with the party, Jung Heewon and I followed Yoo Joonghyuk.

Jung Heewon had a lot of hostility from earlier, as if she didn't like the way he arbitrarily split and gave orders to the party.

"I don't like it, but should I go with you?"

"Be patient. He's not doing it with bad intentions. Rather, it's a positive sign."

The mere fact that Yoo Joonghyuk naturally included us in his party was enough to touch me.

Who is this Yoo Joonghyuk? It's not another Yoo Joonghyuk, it's Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st turn.

If I meet Kim Dokja later, I will definitely tell him about what happened today.

"Are you going north?"

Because Yoo Joonghyuk sent a wary look, I laughed shamelessly.

"Don’t you have a younger sister in the north? Are you worried?"

"You bastard."

"If you don't get her right now, the timing will be difficult."

As I said it, I wondered what I was talking about.

Because I was Cheon Inho.

And Cheon Inho, in the 40th turn, had killed all of Yoo Joonghyuk’s acquaintances.

Even if Yoo Joonghyuk pulled out a great spear and stabbed me to death, I had nothing to say.

Yoo Joonghyuk stopped walking, glared at me for a moment, and then said to Jung Heewon.

"Is your name Jung Heewon?"

"So what?"

"A sniper is hiding on the ninth floor of the building ahead. Eliminate them and return."

Jung Heewon looked carefully at the building Yoo Joonghyuk pointed at.

"Looks like nothing is there?"

"Go."

At Yoo Joonghyuk’s words, a fiery heat and bloodthirstiness radiated from Jung Heewon's body.

I quickly interjected.

"Heewon-ssi."

"Are you okay?"

Jung Heewon and I both know that there are no snipers in that building.

"It’s okay."

Jung Heewon sighed lightly, and eventually shook her hand and stepped forward.

"Don't die before I get back."

"I don't die that easily."

"Then why do you keep dying?"

"Go ahead."

With the sound of the cool wind, Jung Heewon disappeared into the building. Even after her figure disappeared, Yoo Joonghyuk did not open his mouth for a while.

He was looking at the distant sky with solemn eyes. I could see the dark sunset dwelling in his pupils, burning red.

"Cheon Inho."

"Yes."

"Are you really Cheon Inho?"

As expected, Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to have noticed.

"That is a philosophical question. How do you see it?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me quietly and then spoke.

"If you play the role of 'Cheon Inho', you are still Cheon Inho."

"Then I am Cheon Inho."

I don't know if he liked my answer or not. However, Yoo Joonghyuk just looked at me with the same eyes as usual.

From the side of the building, the sound of thrashing was heard. I don't know, but it seemed that Jung Heewon was beating everything up.

How much time has passed?

Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth with a voice that seemed to spread ripples on the calm surface of the water.

"Then, to Cheon Inho, I'll ask."

Yoo Joonghyuk was watching me.

No, it was more like looking at the empty space between me and him.

As if he could sense the invisible wall there.

"Who the hell is 'Kim Dokja'?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 624 Episode 14 Hunting (3)

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The moment I heard that name, my heart sank.

「Yoo Joonghyuk knows Kim Dokja.」

But how did he know his name? Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st turn must have never seen or met Kim Dokja.

He may have met Kim Dokja in the 0th turn, but Yoo Joonghyuk did not know that he was Kim Dokja, and all his related memories were lost in the next turn.

Then how…

「"There were a lot of weird guys from the beginning of this turn."」

Come to think of it, Yoo Joonghyuk must have heard the name from the beginning of this conversation.

「"I'm sure they were nothing until the last turn, but they suddenly came up to me and said strange things as if they were writing something."」

There must have been readers who approached him, referring to themselves as Kim Dokja. It's obvious what those readers would have said, but..

「"Someone said he needed a companion to pass the 46th scenario, he said he was a prophet. There was also a guy who said he would take me to the end of this world."」

At first, he might have thought they were ignorant people, but now, of course, he must have changed his mind.

He must have known of the existence of the apostles by now.

Maybe he overheard the fight between me and Han Sooyoung while suffering from 'regressive depression'.

Even if he hadn't heard, the timing was enough to overhear what the apostles were saying.

「"Is there really Kim Dokja in this world?"」

「"I don't know. But I heard he was on the roof of the theater dungeon?"」

The roof of the Theater Dungeon. The only people there were me, Yoo Joonghyuk, Han Sooyoung, and Jung Heewon.

"Are you 'Kim Dokja' by any chance?"

I shook my head hurriedly as I saw Yoo Joonghyuk having a big misunderstanding.

"Absolutely not."

Yoo Joonghyuk’s expression became even more serious.

"Then, who the hell is Kim Dokja? What the hell is he doing so everyone is talking about his name?"

"That..."

Who is Kim Dokja?

I couldn't come up with an exact sentence as to what kind of answer I should give.

"Kim Dokja... It’s just the name of a person who likes stories more than anyone."

"Stories?"

"He's been reading a single story for a very long time."

"What do you mean? Are you talking about a constellation?"

"Therefore—"

When I said one or two sentences, sentences came to my mind like firecrackers exploded in my head.

「"What kind of person is ahjussi? Ahjussi is..."」

A girl's voice echoed in my head. Her nostalgic blonde hair rippled like waves.

「"The strongest constellation in the universe."」

The boy's brown hair playfully scattered beside her.

「"What? Don't ask me difficult questions. But after talking about it, I suddenly have a craving for squid. Master! Where is Master!"」

Along with the faint smell of the sea, my mind became more and more confused.

「"I found that expression in a book I read a while ago. He's like a childhood friend I've never met."」

It seemed like there was a mild library smell coming from somewhere.

「"The world I want to protect."」

It seemed like there was a bloody smell mixed with the smell of iron.

「"Are you talking about Kim Dokja? That's... um, did I mention I lost my bulletproof helmet before?"」

「"Hyunsung-ssi, please do it in only one paragraph."」

A familiar joke leaked. Then came a sweet typing sound, like a soft crack.

「"The child who decided to read more than three thousand chapters."」

It wasn't a sentence I wrote. So what are these sentences? These sentences,

「"A stupid bastard."」

Where did these memories come from?

The world was dizzy, as if somewhere the blood vessels in my head were clogged. My irregularly beating heart hurt.

I staggered while covering my head.

「Who is Kim Dokja?」

Along with a throbbing headache, sentences were erupting like a volcano.

「Why is he still reading this story?」

When I came to my senses, blue sparks swirled around me.

When I raised my head in a daze, I saw Yoo Joonghyuk. Yoo Joonghyuk was shouting something.

「Don't listen.」

But no voice was heard.

Instead, what I heard were words from the far side of time.

「You should be happy.」

My head was covered with pure white lines like volcanic ash, and I lost consciousness.

---

A light traditional sound coming from the distant sky.

Han Sooyoung realized that the sparks surrounding her had opened up.

'The aftermath of probability has weakened.'

Looking at the traces of the probability aftermath that shimmered faintly at her fingertips, Han Sooyoung remembered what had happened on the roof of the Theater Dungeon a few days ago.

She went there to finish this story, where she met Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st turn.

Yoo Joonghyuk was strong.

It wasn't just strong, he was incredibly strong.

At this point in just the 41st turn, it's to the point where she can't understand how strong he has become.

She fought to the best of her ability and even managed to subdue him with expedient methods.

Up until there it was as planned.

Afterwards, Jung Heewon came out and it was fine until an unknown writer from another world line appeared.

It was a common occurrence when she was writing.

A forgotten foreshadowing pops up, or a character does something different from what the author thought.

Her writing was always about judging her raging unconscious, so she was used to dealing with unpredictable situations.

This is because she was a professional writer who had already completed numerous stories.

However, the story of the man who came to her was something she could not handle.

「Another Kim Dokja she forgot was there.」

Han Sooyoung stumbled at her momentary headache and placed her hands on the outer wall.

There was twilight beyond the shady alley. She saw the landscape of Seoul through the alleyways, as if the horizontal map of Seoul had been cut into a single section.

Bodies of people scattered all over the place. People who died while running away from a fight. The familiar smell of blood.

It was a story she never wanted to go through again.

Nonetheless, she returned to this story once again.

She had no choice but to do so.

Because this story was for her only reader.

"I’m tired."

She knows that the scenery is not all of this world. The line spacing is always wider than the sentence. Therefore, there will be precious stories left between the lines that this alleyway did not contain.

But she didn't have the energy to read between the lines now.

She told herself that the world right now is just one hell of a reflection at the entrance of an alleyway.

"How's the year, Kim Dokja?"

Kim Dokja, who would answer the question, was not there.

Han Sooyoung, who had been looking up at the sky in a daze, took a deep breath and stood up from her seat.

"After..."

Terrible muscle pain spread all over her body.

Her incarnation body was greatly damaged.

It must be so.

It was a miracle that she was still sane after wasting so much of her probability on the rooftop.

Thanks to the temporarily weakened probability aftermath, it was now barely possible to maneuver.

"Someone is having an accident somewhere."

Seeing the sky twinkle in the distance, maybe someone is doing something great to steal <Star Stream>'s attention.

"Lee Gilyoung."

She called his name, but there was no response. Han Sooyoung pressed her lips together once, and then began to slowly move her steps while holding on to the outer wall of a nearby building.

She couldn't stay here.

She has to move.

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' looks at you.]

Han Sooyoung hesitated for a moment, then she moved her steps again.

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' advises you to rest now.]

"Noisy."

Sparks flickered lightly in the air at that bluntness. It's her star getting mad at her.

"Don’t waste your chance on something like that, Yoo Sangah. Where are Lee Gilyeong and you?"

[The constellation 'Lotus blooming under the moonlight' says that Lee Gilyoung is eating now.]

Someone is about to die here, but someone seems to be able to eat well.

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' asks if you are okay.]

What?

[The constellation 'Lotus blooming under the moonlight' says that your complexion looks bad.]

For Han Sooyoung, it was a small burden.

Perhaps Yoo Sangah would not have seen the roof of the Theater Dungeon because the relay channel was closed at the time.

Han Sooyoung was about to say something, but shut her mouth again.

What would Yoo Sangah look like if she knew that 49% of Kim Dokja, whom they had turned away from at that time, was now here?

"What world line did you go on? Are you done recovering Kim Dokja’s fragments already?"

[The constellation 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight' says that she is roughly finished.]

"Then, now really only this place is left. How about Yoosung?"

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' says that Yoosoung is preparing to deploy soon.]

"Are there any other kids? Aren't Lee Hyunsung and Jung Heewon all over?"

[The constellation 'Lotus blooming under the moonlight'...]

It was then that Han Sooyoung turned her head. The moment she reflexively bent her back, a dagger flew and pierced the spot where she was standing.

A blade filled with pitch black magic.

Han Sooyoung asked, frowning.

"What kind of bastard… Come out."

Then black figures appeared simultaneously on both sides of the alley.

They weren't human.

Shepherd-like dogs, three or four times her size, bared their fangs at her.

Monstrous species?

No. It was different from the usual monster species.

[A 7th-class demon species, 'Keeper of Cognition' reveals its teeth.]

Demon species.

Han Sooyoung bit her lip secretly.

"Demons, it's not the time for hell magicians to appear yet."

Then the dog in the middle of the pack opened its mouth.

[It's been a while, Han Sooyoung]

The moment she heard its voice, Han Sooyoung got goosebumps from it.

It was a mantra with a lot of noise, but it was a tone she had heard somewhere.

"You know my name?"

[Whoops, is there anyone in this universe who doesn't know you?]

Han Sooyoung did not hesitate and brought out an Unbreakable Faith.

'I don't know who he is.'

A blade of white light that burns white. As it was, she stepped on the wall of the alley and leaped like a shot, decapitating the demon dog in front of her.

'It's over in no time.'

No matter how demonic it is, there is no 7th grade monster in the scenario that can deal with the current Han Sooyoung.

Surely it should be.

Tsutsutsut.

With a light spark, the head of the demon dog that had been severed was reattached.

Han Sooyoung did not miss the unprecedented story.

"A deity from another world?"

The dogs looked up at the sky and let out a long cry at the same time.

The sky around the area was dyed black, and one of the lights around it was turned off and darkness flowed.

Something bit her calf in the dark with a gurgling sound.

Followed by arms and waist, Han Sooyoung thought as she calmly blew off each of the devil's heads.

'Someone else.'

A deity in another world who commands demon species and knows her name. Can such an existence exist in this 41st turn?

'Must I use the Giant story?'

If I borrowed more tales from here, she would be hit with a probability aftermath again, but there was no other way for now.

In order to deal with the divinity of the other world, she had no choice but to pay the price.

[Are you going to use the Giant story?]

As if it had read her thoughts, she heard an eerie laugh.

Han Sooyoung started acting without answering.

[The Giant story 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 begins its storytelling.]

But at that moment, a sudden light flashed before her eyes, and the story was interrupted.

She spit out the rising blood. Regurgitated stories mingled with her breath. Once again, a shady voice was heard.

[Unfortunately, that ability won't be usable here.]

An unbreakable conviction wielded reflexively, it came up with something.

It was impossible. The activation of the tale wasn’t confirmed?

Why?

In the pitch black darkness, she was called once again.

In an instant, Han Sooyoung had a strange feeling. She knew the owner of this laugh.

[Did you forget?]

"You-"

[You know that I have a stake in <The Kim Dokja Company>'s proud story.]

Ominous flow of magic. In that madness, a story she knew well was wriggling.

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]

…How?

The dogs around her burst into her tune. They seemed to welcome her back to this hell once again.

[You are no longer the author of this story.]

In an instant, a hand made of stories appeared in the darkness. Before she had time to escape, a hand gripped her neck.

With the light of 'Unbreakable Faith' fading, the shadow of a swimmer floating in the air was reflected on the wall of the alleyway.

As if fixing a struggling shadow, a voice came to put an end to a story.

[Please die here, Han Sooyoung.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 625 Episode 14 Hunting (4)

The old stories that choked Han Sooyoung were talking.

The sentences you write end here.

You are no longer the author of this story.

Did you know that you would be able to reach an end even if you forgot about us?

[Looks like you can hear those words now.]

These stories of another world were all sentences written by her at one time.

Forgotten sentences.

Fragments of a story created by the words of promises that were not kept.

Like babies searching for their mother, forgotten stories burrowed into her throat.

Han Sooyoung activated her magic.

If she couldn't use her 'Giant story', her first priority was to somehow escape.

Fortunately for her, she had one skill that suited her.

Her specialty is that she is a writer.

Even when she was struck by an unexpected blow while trying to stop the fight between Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk, she survived thanks to this skill.

However.

[Do you want to use an avatar?]

One of the "Hell's Sentinels" rose completely from its seat, and then took on a human appearance.

He took out a sword from his lofty arms covered in black robes.

Han Sooyoung immediately recognized the item.

'Criminal Disaster Sword'.

The constellation engraved on the death sword burned brightly. It was the man who manifested the authority of the 'Sword of Death' in his own story.

The moment his sword's trajectory cut through the air, Han Sooyoung was overcome with pain as if her mind was being split in half.

'Cut off.'

The link with the dummy [Avatar] that she had maintained all along was broken.

The Power of the Death Sword. The power that cuts the ties of her horoscope cut the ties between her and [Avatar].

In this case, it is impossible to escape using [Avatar's Memory Transfer].

If she dies here, she will really die.

[You will die here.]

For the first time, cold sweat hit Han Sooyoung's forehead.

She was strong, meticulous, and cunning.

If she had just entered the 41st turn, she would not have suffered so badly.

But now she had used too many stories.

[If you hadn't met him. If you hadn't wasted your stories to revive him... Do you regret it now?]

Han Sooyoung's lips tingled.

[You couldn't have abandoned him. Because he is in this world because of you. Because the ending you wanted to see ended up ruining the whole story.]

The power of stories exploded in Han Sooyoung's body.

The Giant story couldn’t be used, but that didn't mean she couldn't use her stories at all.

[Story 'The False Savior' begins its storytelling]

Blood trickled down Han Sooyoung's mouth. Her arms, which slowly regained strength, tore appart the stories' grip on her neck.

Snow flakes dissipated from her breath, and the muscles all over her body were squeezed in pain.

Even in the midst of fainting, Han Sooyoung focused on the enemy in front of her.

"You...."

She was used to that magic that swayed in the dark.

An enemy who could corner her so much that she was caught off guard.

The ability to command demons as subordinates.

A deity who knows her and shares her story with <Kim Dokja’s Company>.

Even after searching through the entire universe, there were only a few such beings.

"I heard you were dead. How did you get here?"

[Are you recognizing me now?]

In the dark, the appearance of the Hell's Keeper began to change.

[Obviously I was dead. In 'The Story You Wrote'.]

The dog's muzzle shortened completely, and then the human face was revealed.

[You think you know the whole story?]

Taking off his robe with a white smile, he had an appearance resembling Kim Dokja.

[My new name is RepresentativeKimDokja. Isn't that interesting? In the story you wrote, there was no existence like this.]

Han Sooyoung grabbed the Unbreakable Faith that fell to the floor.

Along with the sound of 'Gi-i-i-i-i', the sword containing the legend spewed out brilliance.

She said, "I didn't write it because I didn't have to."

Han Sooyoung's sword strikes poured out at the running dogs.

"I'll kill you again."

She had such a feeling.

She must not let the guy in front of her live at all costs. Even if she and all her stories are finished here, she must kill him right here.

She has to do it for Kim Dokja, not for anyone else.

[It can't be done by you now.]

Han Sooyoung swung her sword without answering.

No matter what anyone says, she was the writer of Ways of Survival and Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

She has seen the end of the scenarios twice, and is the one who has knocked down countless stars from the sky.

Ha-ska!

The dazzling white light of long-held beliefs illuminated the darkness.

The second and third sword attacks continued before the devil's throat even regenerated.

Cut off his arms and break his legs. The fragments rolling on the floor are burned with black flames so that they cannot be reproduced.

Han Sooyoung proceeded to thoroughly defeat the demons one by one.

Dogs kept appearing out of nowhere.

Tenacious demon dogs.

As if they had been trained to hunt only her all her life, the dogs gnawed at her arms and legs in sync with her movements.

Nevertheless, Han Sooyoung was optimistic about the situation.

She who used her power of storytelling was also in danger, but the other side in front of her was also sacrificing his formidable probability. There was no way that the <Star Stream> would allow such a large amount of power to be summoned in the initial scenarios.

In other words, this was a game of probability, and when it came to such a fight, Han Sooyoung was confident.

If she holds on a little longer, the other side will lose their strength too.

However, no matter how much she blew the heads of the dogs that were charging at her, there was no harbinger of a probability aftermath.

Why?

Koo-goo-goo-goo!

Belatedly, the 'Great Hall' shimmering in the sky caught her eye.

Prelude to the fifth scenario.

The moment she saw the sparks flashing near the 'Great Hall', Han Sooyoung's hairline became soft.

The unknown deities on the other side of the hall shared the probability of this battle.

"Why?"

Why do the Outer Gods help him?

At that moment, a hypothesis flashed through her mind.

「It wasn't <Kim Dokja’s Company> that crossed through the world lines.」

Tsutsutsutsutsutsutsu!

The balance of the body that was barely holding on collapsed. When the power of the story was cut off, the aftermath of probability began to eat away at her as an incarnation.

Han Sooyoung looked up at the sky resentfully.

No matter how much Outer Gods helped, in the end, it was only possible with the permission of this world.

Everything is possible with the connivance of the stars.

The <Star Stream> of the 41st turn made the decision to exclude her who intervened in their scenario.

"…The <Star Stream> as well."

Han Sooyoung’s arm fell, powerless, and the light of her Unbroken Faith went out.

'This far.'

Han Sooyoung does not like developments where everything flows in a pre-determined sequence. A story without surprise is obvious and lazy.

Her readers will soon notice that she's playing her tricks.

「Nevertheless, Han Sooyoung couldn’t come up with a sentence to break this situation.」

With that, Han Sooyoung felt that she had fulfilled her role.

Perhaps even Kim Dokja somewhere in the sky might not be curious about the story she wrote.

Even in this world.

「"You're not trying to finish the story, you're giving up."」

Because there are already other writers.

However, thinking that the ending was right in front of her eyes, she felt regretful.

She might still have more sentences to write, but there must be something she couldn't say to him.

"Really, it's a very difficult world to be happy in."

Her knees bent.

In her last moment, Han Sooyoung moved her trembling hand and pulled something out of her arms. Her little hand held a lemon candy.

Stories were flowing in the small candy.

A very old story. Old and missed sentences loved by only one reader.

Han Sooyoung stared at the candy for a long time, then she fell down, as if her energy had run out.

Seeing Han Sooyoung like that, RepresentativeKimDokja laughed.

[Great last sentence, Han Sooyoung.]

A black claw protruded from the darkness towards the neck of the unconscious Han Sooyoung.

[What happens to a writer who has no more stories to write, after all.]

It was then that a star twinkled across the sky.

As the dazzling sunlight illuminated the alleyway, 'RepresentativeKimDokja' looked up with a frown.

[Have you come to disturb me again?]

[Constellation, 'Lotus blossoming under the moonlight' is glaring at RepresentativeKimDokja.]

[If you want to intervene, come. But it will be different from last time.]

Despite the terrifying starlight swirling in the sky, 'RepresentativeKimDokja' was not shaken.

[Do you think you, who do not even have a proper incarnation, dare to manifest directly here?]

In the next moment, the entire alley was bathed in bright light.

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' blooms white.]

Surprised, RepresentativeKimDokja looked around.

Hopefully it can't be.

No matter how much it is, 'Lotus that blooms under the Moonlight' can’t dare to go against the law of the <Star Stream> and manifest in the beginning scenarios—

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' smiles.]

An arrow flew out of nowhere and grazed his cheek.

The 7th grade devils who were guarding him screamed and crouched down.

"Shoot!"

A cry from the other side of the alley. Incarnations dressed as government soldiers were shooting arrows toward the alley.

"Kill the demons!"

When RepresentativeKimDokja, frowning, waved his hand, the rain of arrows that flew in disappeared in an instant.

[Foolish-]

Then, the new model of Han Sooyoung, who was in the middle of the alley a while ago, was not visible.

The sound of wires came from somewhere. An incarnation, carrying the fallen Han Sooyoung, was already running away.

"Shoot! Keep shooting!"

Hearing the wrath of the gods, RepresentativeKimDokja held back his accusations.

[Oh, really.]

It wasn't difficult to hit the flying arrows. However, he was also in a position where he could not attack the incarnations.

It is because the size of the 'Great Hall' was gradually shrinking, and the foreboding of a probability storm has been lingering in his entire body.

It was natural.

He is the deity of the lofty otherworld.

Attacking 'Han Sooyoung', an irregular from another world line, and dealing with the incarnations of the beginning scenarios are not likely to be equal.

RepresentativeKimDokja said after staring at the twinkling stars in the sky for a while.

[Kim Dokja’s Company. A story where no one dies, how long do you think this will be possible?]

With one last question, his new model disappeared into the darkness.

"He ran away!"

Eventually, the rain of arrows from the incarnations stopped.

"It's an item! It's the skin of a demon!"

The incarnations who discovered the body of the dead demon species cheered.

Moments later, the incarnation, who was running with Han Sooyoung on their back, stopped walking on the roof.

"You’re safe now."

A soft, gentle voice. Han Sooyoung, who came to her senses, lifted her eyelids in confidence. She could see the scenery around her through her gloomy vision.

In the landscape of the night where the moonlight descended on her, she saw the embodiment of the small body holding her.

"Yoo Sangah?"

No. Although the atmosphere was touching, it was definitely different from Yoo Sangah.

But at first glance, a familiar face was shown. More than anything else, she couldn't tell who it was if she looked like that.

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' tells the incarnation 'Han Sooyoung' that it's okay to rest.]

Han Sooyoung glanced blankly at the sky and slowly closed her eyes. The stars in the sky twinkled once again.

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' expresses gratitude for your help.]

Then, the incarnation carrying Han Sooyoung said.

"We have to help each other and live. By the way... It's amazing. I didn't know this person really existed."

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' asks if you know her.]

"Should I say that I know… I think it’s a bit complicated."

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' asks if you can take care of her.]

"Sure."

[The constellation 'Lotus flower that blooms under the moonlight' looks at Han Sooyoung with pity.]

The incarnation also nodded her head as if agreeing with her.

"Anyway, writers are all the same."

She poked at the sleeping Han Sooyoung's cheek as if it were strange, and said.

"The manuscript she was asked to write is unwritten and wasteful of energy, and her health care is a mess..."

[The constellation 'Lotus that blooms under the moonlight' asks how you know it so well.]

The incarnation, who looked down at Han Sooyoung's face, smiled bitterly.

"My writer did the same."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 626 Episode 14 Hunting (5)

rlaehrwk37: But isn’t he passing out too often?

When I opened my eyes again, it was night. In the faint hunger and thirst, I blinked my eyes, then raised my upper body.

How many times have I fainted?

At this point, it was not the time to tease Kim Dokja by calling him a 'fainting man'.

Kim Dokja.

I didn't get to meet Kim Dokja this time. Usually, whenever I passed out, I met him in the snowfield.

An old table and countertop were visible in the dim darkness.

I wondered what kind of kitchen it was, but it seemed to be inside a nearby restaurant.

"Woke up?"

In the darkness, Jung Heewon's face appeared.

"Ah yes."

Jung Heewon, who had her hair done with pride, was sharpening her knife under the moonlight.

While I was feeling something eerie, I held out the temperance pot that Jung Heewon had placed next to me.

"Would you like to eat this?"

Inside the pot were several grains of gourd crops and roasted foreleg.

"I'm not good at cooking, so I only seasoned it. There was some seasoning left in the restaurant."

"Oh, thank you."

Come to think of it, I haven't eaten anything all day.

When I ate food rich in seasoning after a long time, the taste buds on the tip of my tongue went cold.

It was a melting feeling.

As the hunger and thirst subsided, I thought that I would live a little longer, and I was on the verge of fainting.

The situation came to mind spontaneously.

I was having a conversation with Yoo Joonghyuk. Jung Heewon was away for a while to catch the sniper.

Yoo Joonghyuk asked me who Kim Dokja was, and I thought about it… and passed out?

Jung Heewon held out water to me as I choked on food.

"Thank you."

Looking back, I couldn't understand the last situation.

Why did I faint while thinking about Kim Dokja?

Wait, other than that.

"Where is Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"He went alone."

Jung Heewon answered, changing her words indifferently.

"Leaving us?"

Jung Heewon only nodded. But why do you keep being like that?

With a thud, Jung Heewon put down the clean knife.

I had a feeling that something wasn't right.

I think she’s going to get mad.

"I thought I told you not to die."

A strangely sparkly voice.

"Did you know how surprised I was?"

Jung Heewon glared at me with her eyes narrowed. I hurriedly narrowed my eyes and apologized.

"I-I'm sorry. But I don't know why that happened either. I passed out all of a sudden."

"Really?"

"Yes, really."

"It can't be. Were you threatened by that man?"

"No."

"Weren’t you beaten or mistreated? Take off your shirt."

"I'm not, really."

I answered while sneaking away from Jung Heewon, who reached out.

"I didn't really do anything. I just passed out while talking. I guess I'm a bit tired."

Jung Heewon blinked in disbelief and sighed.

"My God. It was real."

When I saw the expression on her face, there was a situation that was drawn in my head belatedly.

No way?

She dismissed the sniper at the request of Yoo Joonghyuk. The situation where we were away, but I was lying on the spot when she returned.

"Did you fight?"

"We were about to fight."

Jung Heewon pursed her lips and said.

"But he said he felt a bit unfair. He said he didn't do anything, but Inho-ssi collapsed by himself."

"So what?"

"Of course I didn't believe it. Does that make sense?"

It makes no sense.

"I almost got into trouble."

"I was almost on the verge of drawing a knife, but the words of Dansu-ahjussi came to mind."

Dansu-ahjussi?

"Before we broke up, the man said that, if I go out with that man, there will be a situation where I will get angry all of a sudden, and then go to sleep."

"Oh."

I really appreciate Dansu-ahjussi’s wise judgment.

"He said there could be a misunderstanding."

Even in the past, the Dansu-ahjussi was misunderstood alone when everyone thought of Yoo Joonghyuk badly.

He said it might be.

Ahjussi’s wisdom is really amazing.

"The misunderstanding is correct. I really fell alone."

"Then I'm glad."

By the way, Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Dokja became a company at most, but he went away like this.

"Where did Yoo Joonghyuk go?"

"To the north."

If it's in the north, he must have gone to rescue his younger sister, Yoo Mia.

Because right now is the right time.

"Do you have anything else to say?"

"He said he wouldn’t go out with you anymore."

"Yes?"

"He doesn’t need a weak guy who faints all the time…"

It was embarrassing, but it was right.

"The current Inho-ssi cannot properly play the role of Cheon Inho, and he told me to tell you that."

Yoo Joonghyuk said, if I could play the role of Cheon Inho, he would believe that I am Cheon Inho.

In other words, it means that I am now disqualified.

Damn it.

Of course, to miss Yoo Joonghyuk at such an important moment.

My mind was complicated.

Soon, the battle for the flag will be over, and the 'King's Road' scenario will begin.

Then, going to the 'absolute throne' will be in an instant.

"But Inho-ssi, why do you want to hang out with him?"

Jung Heewon asked as if she did not understand.

"You haven't forgotten what kind of person he is, right? Me and Inho-ssi, we were in danger because of him."

Hearing that, I remembered that I hadn't explained anything to Jung Heewon until now.

Jung Heewon could not understand this situation, because that Yoo Joonghyuk was a human who threw me and Jung Heewon as food for sea monsters.

"Is there a reason you have to be with that person all this time?"

"Yes."

In the end, it was Yoo Joonghyuk who held the key to this world. He is a regressor of the 41st round.

The strongest incarnation.

However, that Yoo Joonghyuk eventually met a tragic ruin at the end of the 41st turn.

In order to prevent that ending, I had no choice but to correct his risky behaviors one by one.

Jung Heewon opened her mouth after a while.

She said, "I heard that Inho-ssi is also an apostle. Is it a problem related to that?"

I involuntarily stopped breathing. When I raised my head, I saw Jung Heewon with a dark complexion.

How long did Jung Heewon ponder over it before asking that question?

"You're right."

A feeling of late guilt came over me.

As Yoo Joonghyuk said, if I was 'Cheon Inho' now, it was Jung Heewon in front of me who protected me.

I could not have survived at Geumho Station and Chungmuro Station without her help.

And to her, I left out important explanations.

「Throughout the scenario, Jung Heewon would have been confused.」

For her, who was an ordinary person, the cataclysm of her world, the scenarios and the constellations as well. It must have been a difficult story.

But in the meantime, the apostles who knew her future appeared, and even those apostles were her own companions.

"Sorry. I haven't told you anything for too long. Where did you hear that I'm an apostle?"

"Just all over the place. I heard people talking."

Even if she pretended not to hear or not see, it seemed that she was actually listening. Even so, Jung Heewon waited for me to speak all along.

"Do you know the 'future' of this world, too?"

"Yes. I know."

Now is the time to talk to Jung Heewon. Just like Kim Dokja did in the main story, I also have to break through this head-on.

I slowly got up from my seat and bowed my head to Jung Heewon.

"Sorry for hiding it for so long. I won't make excuses. I know the future of this world, and I knew of Heewon-ssi's existence from before."

"Oh."

Embarrassed by my sudden apology, Jung Heewon stood up from her seat.

"To prevent the destruction of this world, Heewon's help was absolutely necessary. Actually, that's why I tried to become friends with Heewon-ssi."

Since Jung Heewon had come this far, I couldn't hide it any longer. Because that’d be deceiving her.

"So you were trying to be friendly with me?"

"Yes."

She shuddered and thought there was nothing she could do. But some relationships can't go forward unless they're particularly weak.

I bit my lip and quietly lifted my head. Of course, I thought Jung Heewon would have a disappointed face.

Rather, she had a puzzled expression.

"But... I didn't really feel that way. I was the one who went and talked to you first when I was alone, wasn't it?"

I pondered.

"That… I guess I was lucky."

"If I hadn't been Jung Heewon, wouldn't we have become close?"

I thought for a moment.

If Jung Heewon wasn't Jung Heewon, would I have been close to her?

"No. I think we wouldn't."

The person I liked was Jung Heewon, and the person I needed was also Jung Heewon. She may be angry, but it was a meaningless assumption to me in the first place.

"As expected, Inho-ssi is honest."

"Sorry."

"What do you have to be sorry about? Thank god, because I am Jung Heewon."

"Yes."

"Because I am Jung Heewon, Inho-ssi risked his life for me. It was the same on the bridge and the Theater Dungeon back then. If Inho-ssi wasn't there, I would have died that day."

How is this person…

A sentence came to mind with a momentary sense of tingling.

「That I was able to come this far thanks to her.」

I unknowingly bit my lip. Why does that sentence come to mind now?

「"Thank you for finding me. I'm not being sarcastic, I mean it."」

How can this person be so consistent even though the speaker is different?

"I'm going crazy too. I am alive here thanks to Heewon."

Even knowing that the sentences in my memory do not explain the Jung Heewon in front of me, it was hard to hide my excitement.

Jung Heewon said with a smile.

"Actually, I didn't want to ask until the end. I wanted you to tell me someday. But, on the roof of the Theater Dungeon, I had a rather strange experience. From then on, I was a bit confused."

The roof of the Theater Dungeon.

I belatedly remembered what had happened with Han Sooyoung.

["This world, that, no…"]

There, Han Sooyoung showed Jung Heewon the story of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

"What was the story about?"

How else am I supposed to explain that?

"It's a story from a different world than this one."

No matter how much I thought about it, it was best to return Jung Heewon's answer as it was.

"Then all the stories she told me really happened."

"Yes, that's right."

I thought for a moment about the story of that world.

The world where Kim Dokja and <Kim Dokja Company> existed. A world where Jung Heewon became the judge of destruction and Cheon Inho died at her hands.

"In that world, Inho-ssi was a complete badass."

In Jung Heewon's hand was a well-forged Mikazuki Munechika.

I thought of Cheon Inho, who was killed by her sword.

Cheon Inho, the villain of 'Geumho Station' who instigated, killed, and extorted coins at will.

Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint. Even though it was Han Sooyoung who first wrote it, I certainly wrote a sentence about it with sincerity.

I fiercely wrote sentences that harass, kill, and torment people.

Because it's villainous, because it's more violent, brutal, and probable.

If so, this moment may be the moment when I get back the 'probability' I used at that time.

"Is the Inho-ssi in front of me the same person as Inho-ssi over there?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 627 Episode 14 Hunting (6)

"I am."

I couldn't answer right away.

Obviously, I wasn't that 'Cheon Inho'. Their way of thinking was different, and their likes and dislikes were different.

Their soul was different.

But can I really say that I have nothing to do with that 'Cheon Inho'?

I possessed his body, and before I possessed it, I wrote a sentence about him.

I made 'Cheon Inho' with my own hands.

Even if Han Sooyoung wrote the first draft, I had plenty of opportunities to change the sentences.

If so, maybe I—

"You are a different person."

Jung Heewon frowned as if she didn't understand why I was taking so long.

"No matter how you look at it, you're a different person. I also saw that world. You have different personalities, and you look closely... Cheon Inho here is more attractive."

I couldn't figure out what the hell she was talking about.

"Inho-ssi said, 'Another world'. Then, isn't it a world that doesn't exist on this side? It's like a world in a novel."

A world of fiction.

"The reason I asked is because I just wanted to hear a set answer. That's all. So tell me. Inho-ssi, are you the same person as Cheon Inho in that world?"

I suddenly came to my senses.

The hand that Jung Heewon reached out to first. If I didn't hold this hand, that wasn't polite either.

"I'm not like him. At least I think so."

"Yes?"

But is that really enough?

Will she be able to understand and move on with that alone?

"The Cheon Inho I believe in is only the Cheon Inho in front of me right now."

As if [inciting] herself, Jung Heewon said.

"So Inho-ssi too."

Jung Heewon, who came towards me, said while putting the blade on the floor.

"Think of the me in front of you right now as Jung Heewon. Except for Jung Heewon from 'The Future You Know'."

Only then did I know why she brought up this topic.

「The Jung Heewon in front of me is not the Jung Heewon of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.」

Jung Heewon, who was the sword of Kim Dokja.

Jung Heewon, who killed Cheon Inho.

Jung Heewon, the only incarnation of the Demon-like Judge of Fire and the guardian of <Kim Dokja's Company>.

That Jung Heewon is not here.

As I am not 'Cheon Inho', she is also in the stories of the apostles.

She is not that 'Jung Heewon'.

[There is only one Jung Heewon in the 41st turn.]

I sincerely nodded.

Jung Heewon smiled.

"If I fall off a bridge again, will you save me?"

"A few times."

Jung Heewon sighed lightly, bent down to pick up her sword from the floor, and lightly tilted her head.

"I said something too complicated, not like me. Actually, I don't want to think difficult things right now. I like simple things."

Certainly, the Jung Heewon I knew wasn't one to talk about things like this.

"I just want to cut, stab, and somehow survive. That's all I want to do."

"That's enough for now. Instead, please do it by my side."

At those words, Jung Heewon lifted her head at a subtle angle and looked at me.

"I could stab Inho-ssi by mistake?"

"Then I'll die."

Jung Heewon thought it was a joke and laughed.

"That can't be done. Inho-ssi, please come so that I don't stab the wrong person."

"Of course. By the way."

As I slowly looked around the restaurant, I asked a question I had been wanting to ask all along.

"Haven't you already stabbed one?"

There was only one other person in the restaurant besides us.

To be precise, at Jung Heewon’s feet.

---

The man was still breathing.

He was a man whose peculiarities were hard to find except that he was pretending to be homeless.

Well, even that is a feature that has little meaning at this point when everyone is homeless.

"The sniper you just caught? Was there a real sniper?"

"There is."

The man, whose whole body was tightly bound, let out intermittent moans as if he were trying to detach himself.

"Even though the gun was a toy gun."

I checked [character list].

Although he didn't have any particularly great stats or characteristics, there was one skill that stood out.

[Strengthen bullets.]

A skill that changes toy bullets into power comparable to normal bullets. It seemed that he was targeting us with this skill.

After hitting the man on the cheek several times, the man who suddenly came to his senses began crying and begging her.

"Sa-save me! Please!"

"Which group do you belong to?"

I slammed the pot on the floor next to the man's head and asked. After all, this guy is the one who tried to shoot on us.

I was wondering if I should pretend to torture him, but the man shouted in a fit.

"Damn, Beggar! Beggar Sect!"

He spit it out easier than I thought.

By the way... Beggars?

Jung Heewon asked if she had read my expression.

"A group you know?"

I subtly nodded.

There is probably no web novelist who is unaware of the concept of the Beggar Sect.

Because it is the name of the Bangpa that appears regularly in martial arts novels.

The Beggar Sect was a place that represented 'one of the old sects' in Murim.

That is to say, if it was set at a normal time, it was like that.

If there's a problem, I know that the 'Beggar Sect' doesn't come out in Omniscient Reader.

"Where are your headquarters?"

"That, that's..."

Jung Heewon, who was by his side, picked up a knife.

"Above, the location! It's hard to tell because it's so wide, but the main base is on the Seoul Station side!

"Who is the head of the group?"

"It’s Cheongae!"

Opening, Cheongae, Seoul Station.

The first two were never described in detail even when reading the book, but it was different for Seoul Station.

According to my memory, it is because Kim Dokja once monologued as follows.

「Still, that's cute enough. Compared to those in Chungmuro or Seoul Station.」

That was the only description of 'Seoul Station' I read in all of the novel.

I tried to think of other notes, but nothing particularly came to mind.

This is because the vicinity of Seoul Station was only mentioned, but no specific framework was established.

In other words, it means that Han Sooyoung did not convey it to me.

"Why were you spying on us?"

"Chew, the commander told me to keep an eye on the road to expand our power. That's really all. I didn't mean to hurt you!"

Looking at his expression, I thought it was real. After thinking for a while, I suddenly looked down at the man's waist.

Three knots hanging from the waist.

Look at this.

Looking at the knot, I pondered and asked the man.

"Can you specify?"

---

The man could only be released from us after repeated [oaths of existence].

The specifications were simple.

「About us, don't report it to the representative no matter what.」

The leaving man kept bowing his head this way and repeating his thanks.

[Currently, a number of targets have contracted the 'Oath of Existence'.]

[As the number of targets of the 'Existence Specification' increases, the power of the 'Oath' weakens.]

This is another penalty I didn't know about.

Maybe that's why they didn't make the 'Oath to Existence' often in the main story?

Jung Heewon, who watched him walk away, asked.

"Can we let him live?"

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is startled by your behavior.]

"Do you think my judgment is wrong?"

"I just think it's Inho-ssi."

"There is a reason I saved him."

Perhaps that group has already obtained permission for [group chat].

In other words, there was a high possibility that the man did not give information to nearby group members the moment he was caught by Jung Heewon.

In other words, in some way, the information has already been passed on to the other group.

"It's not an ordinary group. The hierarchy within the organization has already been established."

"A hierarchy?"

I explained about the knot tied around the man's waist.

Originally, the group called 'Beggars Sect' is the group of 'beggars' in martial arts novels.

Unusually, they reveal their rank with a 'knot' on their waist. For example, regular members have one 'knot'. Buntaju-class knot 'three'. Dangju's level is the same as 'five'.

"That person had three knots. That means he's on the Buntaju level."

"What is Buntaju?"

"That… In terms of a company, you can roughly think of it as an assistant manager or a manager."

"Isn't it high?"

"Yes, but it is important that there is a rank."

As far as I know, there are up to nine open knots in total.

Just now, since that guy was in the middle ranks, it means that there are six more levels above him.

It's only in the early stages of the scenario, but it was truly surprising that they had already created a group of that size.

"Is this a group created by people who like martial arts novels?"

"It could be that way, or-"

It could be that the constellation is related to Murim.

Either way, it was an opponent that could not be good because we were now hostile.

Above all, 'Kim Dokja' had a group comparable to Chungmuro, so it must be judged that they have at least ten medicines.

Of course, this side has Jung Heewon, but Jung Heewon's real skills are displayed when dealing with monsters rather than people.

"What if he brings a gang? He said he swore, but you never know."

"It'll be all right if he comes."

"Yes?"

If they still come to attack us, then it is a war with clear intentions.

"At that time, you'll be free to kill them."

I wondered if I had made a great remark, but Jung Heewon smiled.

"I like that."

Somehow, it felt like a very bloody duo was created.

I replied with a wry smile.

"Then let’s set off. Did you say Yoo Joonghyuk went north?"

"Well, there’s one thing I didn’t tell you about earlier," Jung Heewon added, scratching her cheek.

"That person, Yoo Joonghyuk, said one more word before he left."

I thought it might be. Yoo Joonghyuk looks cool on the outside, but he is secretly a guy with a lot of lingering feelings.

"The current Cheon Inho cannot be recognized as Cheon Inho. But-"

"But?"

"If we recruit a person as a colleague, he says he will think about recognizing you as 'Cheon Inho'."

It's not about acknowledging me, thinking about acknowledging me is also good.

"The mad butcher... he said you would understand."

"A mad butcher?"

A sentence came to mind.

Apparently, there was one incarnation with such a nickname.

["One of the 100 strongest people in Ways of Survival, the 'Mad Butcher', eventually evolved from the 'Crouching Figure'.]

Surprisingly, however, this person was only mentioned once and passed by. After that, it is not even mentioned whether he is dead or alive.

It's the 100 strongest people in Ways of Survival...

After all, Han Sooyoung didn't tell me this, so there's probably no mention of it.

By the way, Yoo Joonghyuk is looking for that mad butcher...

The story turns out in a fun way.

"Anyone you know?"

"That's what I've heard of."

As soon as I was about to say, "I don't know him," I felt a slight pain in my head once again.

[A new skill is active]

New skill?

「'Mad Butcher' was born at 'Seoul Station' that day.」

A thought that came to my mind.

Since when was it?

Goosebumps slowly formed on my forearms.

It wasn't a sentence that I came up with in particular, nor was it a sentence that originally came out in 'Omniscient Reader'.

It wasn't even a setting I made, and it wasn't a sentence I would write in the future.

[Exclusive skill, 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' is active.]

That is the story that Kim Dokja loved more than anyone else.

It was a sentence of 'Ways of Survival'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 628 Episode 15 Doorbell (1)

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「Baekindohae No.89. 'The Mad Butcher'. Full name unknown. Age unknown. From Korea.」

'The Mad Butcher' has been active in a variety of ways, from <The Devil's Tournament> to <Gigantomachia>. Some nebulae tried to recruit him several times, but it is known that he worked solo to the end, and disappeared in the 90's scenario.

His combat power, which entered the 'state of madness', competes for the top among incarnations, and there is also a record that he clashed with Ranbir Khan of India and engaged in a bloody battle when the giant tale <Mahanaraka> was opened.

The Mad Butcher, who haunts the scenarios like a ghost in search of the enemy who killed his comrades, always wore a 'skeleton mask'. It is said that no one knows the true face of the butcher behind the mask.」

—Bicheonhori 『The 100 Strongest』

---

We went straight to Seoul Station.

There were two main reasons.

One is to find the 'mad butcher' mentioned by Yoo Joonghyuk.

And the other.

[You are currently in the 'Wanderer' state.]

[You must obtain a flag within the next two days.]

Because it was the timing to acquire a new 'flag'.

If I wasn't going to participate in 'The Battle for the Throne', I would have maintained my status as a wanderer and searched for other ways to survive... But since this world was in the 41st turn, I had to prepare for it just in case.

Suddenly, Yoo Joonghyuk could do something strange, or strange guys like the Misreading Association could appear.

If they ever claim the 'absolute throne', this turn will be ruined.

"Are you sure the butcher or something is in Seoul Station?"

I nodded my head at Jung Heewon's question.

"Yes. And there are probably hidden flags around here."

How did I know that?

「Near Seoul Station. There are hidden 'white flags' around Huamdong and Namyeongdong.」

The moment I made up my mind to 'go to Seoul Station', the above sentence naturally came to my mind.

All of them were the effects of the newly acquired skill 'Ways of Survival'.

[Exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' is activated.]

I hadn't figured out the exact way to use it yet.

I knew how to turn the skill on and off, but there was no function to find the content I wanted or to read a specific conversation of 'Ways of Survival'.

It was just that whenever I thought of something or did a certain action, a specific content of 'Ways of Survival' came to my mind like a game help. Of course, even that alone was a great help.

Seeing how I started to hear the sentences of 'Ways of Survival' right after I met Han Sooyoung, I wondered if Han Sooyoung had given me this skill.

But for what reason?

I don't know.

What is certain is that I now have the information of 'Ways of Survival', and because of that, I have an overwhelming advantage over other readers and apostles.

That's it.

We quickly descended southwest to Seoul Station.

Foreigners can often be found when passing through Myeongdong, which is famous as a tourist destination.

It was not exactly foreigners, but the bodies of foreigners.

Most of the scattered corpses were devoured by lower monstrous species and couldn’t be recognized.

We walked, trying to avoid the scenery.

"Wow, this street has changed like this. Have you been to Myeongdong often?"

"A few times when I was in college."

"I used to work part-time at the theater over there."

Jung Heewon pointed to the half-collapsed building and said.

"I'm sure there was..."

In less than a month, Seoul as we knew it was now erased from the world.

As if a new story could only begin when that world collapsed.

"This is where whirlwind potatoes were sold at a really high price. And lobsters."

"Have you ever eaten them?"

"Never. How can you buy something so expensive?"

Streets filled with stalls and crowds of merchants were now covered with corpses of monsters and humans.

"It smelled good, though."

"I know, right?"

The Myeongdong that Jung Heewon remembers and the Myeongdong that I remember will be different.

But now we are standing together in the ruins of Myeongdong, yearning for the street food we thought we would never be able to buy and eat.

"Inho-ssi."

"Yes."

"If you are going to Seoul Station, can I stop by Huamdong for a while? It's right nearby."

Huamdong.

According to 'Ways of Survival', there is a hidden place with a white flag there.

I nodded and asked.

"Do you have anything to see there?"

"There's a place I'd like to stop by."

Places that survivors of the coveted world might want to visit.

I knew where it was without even asking.

---

The past history of Jung Heewon does not appear in 'Ways of Survival'. To be precise, even Jung Heewon is not mentioned. Because she wasn't the main character.

However, the past history of Jung Heewon was not properly dealt with even in 'Omniscient Reader', where she was a leading role in her own way.

Well, it wasn't just Jung Heewon.

The story of Lee Hyunsung's military service was not mentioned, the story of Lee Gilyoung's mother was omitted, the dead puppy of Shin Yoosung was hidden, and the story of Lee Jihye's friend was minimally described.

After all, if it was Han Sooyoung who wrote this story, and <Kim Dokja's Company> was the one who told her story, then why aren't their stories introduced in Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint?

It wasn't hard to guess why.

Perhaps <Kim Dokja's Company> is from Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

Maybe they thought this wasn't their story.

After all, that story was Kim Dokja's story.

"It's here."

The place she guided me to was an apartment for a military unit facing a back alley.

"How many years has it been? It's very old."

"Did you come after a long time?"

"I left home when I was in high school. Didn't I tell you?"

It may or may not have been heard.

"Actually, I didn't want to come, but... I was on my way to Seoul Station."

Did someone remove the bodies? The entrance leading to the parking lot of the apartment was left with only bloodstains.

The apartment security room was smashed as if a monster had pushed it through. The windows on the veranda were broken as if they had been shelled.

Watching the curtains sway through the cracked glass, I thought about the things that had disappeared.

What happened to all the people who originally lived here?

Did they also go through the first scenario? Had they gone through the first scenario, would they have killed their own family, or would they have knocked on the door next

door and put a knife in the neighbor?

I don't know what tragedy happened here.

I was afraid to find out.

「There is a 'white flag' nearby.」

But there is a white flag here, and we must take it. Yes, we will be able to buy tomorrow and the day after tomorrow.

We'll see the end of this damn world.

"This is the house."

Jung Heewon's house was on the 5th floor of the apartment.

I said to Jung Heewon, who was giggling in front of the front door.

"You don't have to go in."

She said she didn't like her family. But even such a family is, after all, a family.

"Heewon-ssi has done enough to come this far."

Old-fashioned sense of duty and guilt. Somewhere in between, Jung Heewon had a lost expression.

Then, for an instant, a firm determination appeared on Jung Heewon's face.

"I'll at least check."

She is also a strong person.

She knocked on the front door a few times and thought for a moment, then she raised the door lock cover and started typing her password.

Beep beep beep. Beep beep beep.

When it was wrong three times, the door opened.

"It's still there."

As soon as she opened the door, I could feel the damp, stagnant air. The smell of a house that hasn't been ventilated for over a week.

Jung Heewon did not take off her shoes as she entered without hesitation. She didn't ask who was there, she didn't even call their name.

I followed her, but after thinking about it for a while, I took off my shoes at her front door.

I took off my shoes next to other shoes, neatly arranged like a towel in a royal palace.

Sneakers were visible.

Probably no one is in this house. I had such a feeling.

Jung Heewon returned with a slightly relieved face, as if she had already looked around her house.

"I don’t think you were both at home."

Was that fortunate or unfortunate?

I do not know.

Perhaps Jung Heewon doesn't know either.

I don't know who the people who lived here were. However, it seemed that they were not the ones who cooked food at home.

I couldn't find food waste in the sink, and I didn't even see a garbage bag.

Jung Heewon stood at the living room window and looked out of her window for a moment.

"You can see the apartment across the street. I lived there when I was young."

"Then, I moved to a mountain village across the street. I've been to the front line, and I also lived in Yongsan for a while. Soldiers move apartments regularly."

Jung Heewon's father was a soldier.

When I was young, I had a friend who had a military father in Jingu, and I had heard a similar story.

"When the place of dispatch changed, I moved to a new neighborhood, and my younger brother and I worked hard to follow my father. If we could adapt, he would move, and if we couldn’t adapt, he would move. After my mother ran away, the cycle accelerated."

Jung Heewon drew a circle on the foggy, dusty window.

"Speaking of, the atmosphere of the neighborhoods is all similar. There is a military base nearby, and there is a unique refugee-like smell of families following soldiers. It is a site where soldiers live, so the government does not give expensive land. If it's Seoul, I wonder if there's a place like this in Seoul... That's why I left the house. I was so bored."

The circling finger stopped.

"I'm tired of those people."

Jung Heewon slowly turned her head and looked around her.

Above the calf-length living room cabinet, I saw a framed family picture. In the photo, there was a middle-aged man in military uniform, a young Jung Heewon, and a boy who appeared to be her younger brother.

Seeing that he was wearing a graduation cap, it was probably a photo taken at the boy's primary school graduation ceremony.

Jung Heewon took out the picture in the frame.

"But when I went out, society was the same."

Looking at that picture reminded me of my parents' faces.

My parents were good people.

They were really good people that I can't describe.

「But Lee Hakhyun didn’t miss them that much.」

I don't know why.

Is it because it's strange that I was born as the child of such good people, or...

「It must have been because I had the impression that it didn’t feel like my life.」

It may be due to the influence of reading too many novels since childhood.

I always read books when I open my eyes, and I lived writing stories.

The place I've lived all along is the world inside the text.

It was a world of light and darkness ruled by dragons, swords, and magic.

「Is that why? Lee Hakhyun has always lived his life with the feeling that he is living someone else's life instead.」

Cheon Inho's narrow eyes were visible on the pitch-black screen of the TV, which was turned off.

A face that is not my face.

Even now I am living someone else's story.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' looks at your face.]

[Constellation 'The Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is curious about your thoughts.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' warns you to stop doing nonsense and go kill other people.]

I put my hand on my face reflected on the screen.

Was the Cheon Inho that I now possessed once someone's child?

Was his family there?

I first thought about the life of a villain who messed up the 40th turn and disappeared.

Where did Cheon Inho's original soul go?

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' feels sorry for you.]

Jung Heewon finally raised her head.

"That's okay. Let’s go now, because this is not our purpose for coming here."

I nodded.

Jung Heewon must have been listening to the message that was ringing in my ears from earlier.

[There is a 'white flag' hidden nearby.]

[The closer you get to the location of the white flag, the shorter the message sending interval.]

There is a 'white flag' somewhere in this apartment.

"I don't think it’s at home."

First of all, it is not in Jung Heewon's house.

By measuring the dispatch interval of the message, it is possible to locate the flag.

At this close distance, the only place I could immediately suspect was... next door.

"I think this is this house."

We stood at the old front door and looked at each other for a moment.

Jung Heewon asked first.

"Should I ring the doorbell? Or should I break it?"

"If there were people inside, they would have captured the flag right away and this message wouldn't ring."

"I see."

"But just in case."

"Which one is it?"

We rang the doorbell of an empty house at the same time.

Of course, there was no reaction from people.

We thought together with a wry smile.

Still, isn't this the humanity we can find in this apocalypse?

But the next moment.

Click.

Someone opened the door from the inside.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 629 Episode 15 Doorbell (2)

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We tensed and exchanged glances.

The sound of hinges resounded ominously. The door was open, but no one came out to greet us.

What lies beyond may be a terrified family member, or a neighbor with a knife trying to harm us.

If that's not the case.

"Who are you?"

The voice of a nervous child. We immediately opened the door.

Through the wide open front door, I saw a scruffy boy. He had a short stature and plump body and cheeks.

He was a kid with a big mole on the bridge of his nose, who looked like he was about 13 or 14 years old.

"Ahhh."

The child, startled to see us, backed away.

Jung Heewon lightly raised both of her hands toward the child.

"Hey, it's okay. We don't want to harm you."

After saying that, she whispered a little to me.

"Probably the kid who went to the same school as my brother."

"How do you know?"

"Dots... No, I remember seeing him on SNS."

She probably recognized the boy by the mole on his nose.

Hearing that, the boy's eyes widened. In an instant, the grouchy boy glanced back and asked us.

"Do you know me? Who are you?"

"Where are the adults? Are you alone?"

"All adults…"

The spotted boy cried and approached step by step. Perhaps feeling sorry for such a boy, Jung Heewon bent down and looked at the child.

Is it because I am Lee Hakhyun or Cheon Inho that I wasn't agitated throughout the entire time I looked at the scenery?

「How on earth did this child survive the first scenario?」

With five steps left, I opened my mouth.

"Little boy."

The boy looked up at me.

I kindly narrowed my eyes and asked.

"Can you not do that?"

Before I could finish my words, the boy dug into Jung Heewon's arms. I reflexively pulled Jung Heewon and stepped forward.

Fortunately, the boy's kitchen knife was blocked by my 'reinforced exterior suit'.

Seeing the kitchen knife lying on the floor, the frightened boy banged his butt.

"Ah, aaaaa! I-I didn't do that on purpose! I was ordered to! I did it because I was told to do it!"

Was it a trap too?

Jung Heewon asked.

"Inho-ssi, are you okay?"

"It's okay, Heewon-ssi."

"Why don’t you listen?"

I said, looking at her right hand, which was already touching the hilt of her sword.

"At least you have to hear the story."

If I hadn't stopped her, the boy would have been cut.

Realizing that fact belatedly, the boy sat down on the floor and stepped back, dragging his butt.

I laughed and bowed like a good cheater.

"So, who made you do this?"

I didn't even have to ask.

No matter how you look at it, it really didn't look like someone ordered it.

To be precise, "Shoot! hurry!"

It looked like 'the one this guy ordered'.

Bang! Bang!

At the same time as the spotted boy's command, a gunfire was heard.

A menacing warning shot. Pieces of broken concrete fell from the ceiling.

Three boys and girls stood beside the spotted boy who quickly stepped back.

Two of them are holding guns.

It was the K-2 used by the military.

The proud spotted boy opened his mouth.

"Did you see it? It’s real weapons."

When I smiled at the threat that continued like a flow of liquidation, the boy warned me with an expression of silence.

"Five counts from now."

Count to five.

And my questions are four.

"One."

Where the hell did these kids come from?

"Two."

I'm self-sufficient, why didn't even Jung Heewon notice the children?

[The consonant tone method (breathing concealment) is activated in the area.]

It's the consonant method. Alright, the second question is solved.

"Three."

How did these kids dig these traps?

"Four."

So far, how many people have you killed?

"Five. Just kill them."

I activated [Incite] and converted 'thought' into 'Hercules's shield'.

[The special skill 'wide area defense' is activated!]

The barrels of K2, which had been turned into continuous fire, spewed fire all at once.

Too-ta-ta-ta!

It is a wide-area defense that has withstood even Gong Pildu's [mini turret], why can’t it just block a normal bullet?

When the bullets fired in succession began to bounce off the shield and make the wrong place in the house into a beehive, the startled children stopped shooting with a scream.

I rushed over and took the guns from the kids. Even if you look at it, it was not difficult to subdue them because they did not have high overall abilities.

The spotted boy shouted as the situation turned against him.

"Hey, now! Get rid of him!"

For an instant, the back of my neck felt cold.

There was something flying fast through the air. It wasn't as fast as the bullet, but I raised my head reflexively to avoid the attack with unusual energy. The attack that pinged and brushed the ball was embedded in the wall and vibrated violently.

It was a chopstick filled with magical power.

When I turned my head, I saw a fifth boy with a spoon holder there.

The boy was unusually wearing a skull mask.

Skull mask?

Perhaps he did not know that I would avoid the attack, but the boy stared at me with agitated eyes and stood firm.

The spotted boy said in an annoyed voice.

"Can't you get that right too?"

"Sorry."

"Throw it back!"

"…There's a cooldown."

Hearing that, the button must have been pressed, and the spotted boy huffed and cursed.

The spotted boy approached with excited steps and struck the skull boy in the stomach and face.

Even then, as if his anger was not resolved, the spotted boy looked back at me.

"You're being kind. But this time you picked the wrong person. Do you know who we are?"

At the words of the spotted boy, the other children, who were shivering with a lot of shrinking, changed their expressions one by one.

As if the words were a 'wide-area defense' to protect them.

"That's right."

"Even the soldiers can't touch us! My sisters and brothers are all dead now!"

Where the hell do these kids come from?

The first question I had was now to be resolved.

A spotted boy with a dark smile waved a knot hidden around his waist.

It was the same knot as the sniper Jung Heewon subdued at the Complaints Building a few hours ago.

The sniper's knots were three, but the spotted boy had five.

Feeling Jung Heewon approaching, I opened my mouth.

"These kids, they’re from the Beggar Sect."

I don't know if she heard me or not. However, Jung Heewon passed by me and walked away.

"That's right. It's our Beggar Sect. Do you know who I am? It is said that I am at the level of the head of the Beggar Sect. You're dead now-"

"Get out of the way"

Jung Heewon, who pushed the spotted boy as if he was in the way, opened her mouth as she walked toward the skeleton boy.

"Jung Eunho."

The moment I heard the voice, the atmosphere went cold.

Is the Jung Heewon I know right there right now?

Was Jung Heewon a person who could make such a bloody expression?

"Take off the mask. Are you Eunho?"

It was the children who reacted first.

Contemplative boys and girls looked at each other with anxious eyes and muttered.

"Who, who are you?"

"Do you know Eunho?"

The boy wearing the skull mask stared at Jung Heewon stiffly.

He twisted his head slightly in disbelief and shook his hand holding the spoon holder.

The boy's eyes reflected through the mask shook violently. Then the boy's hand moved slowly to remove his mask.

Then there.

"...Sister."

There was a boy who looked very much like Jung Heewon.

---

rlaehrwk37: Oh shit.

rlaehrwk99: Is it real?

---

A miraculous reunion of two siblings who survived the hellish apocalypse.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' nods at the tearful sibling reunion.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' observes the situation with a complicated expression.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' says that the spots should be matched.]

If it was normal, it was the timing for the planned new wave to unfold. Tears and runny nose spilled out, the brother and sister hugged each other, brushed off old love and hatred, and realized true family love.

It should have been, but Jung Heewon's family was a bit unusual.

"What the hell have you been up to?"

In spite of Jung Heewon's insistence, Jung Eunho silently lowered his head.

I carefully looked at the skull mask in Jung Eunho's hand.

「The butcher, who searches for the enemy who killed his comrades and went through the scenario like a ghost, always wore a 'skeleton mask'.」

Does that mean that Jung Heewon's younger brother was the 'mad butcher'?

In theory, it was plausible.

'The Mad Butcher' is one of the few incarnations with the characteristics of 'Crouching Figure' mentioned by Kim Dokja.

Jung Heewon also had the 'Crouching Figure', so it was no surprise to me that her younger brother had the same attribute.

Then let's check it out by myself.

[Currently, the skill 'Character List' is being updated.]

[Currently, the skill cannot be used.]

No, at least now?

"Who made you do this? Can't you speak sooner?"

Jung Heewon's cool eyes turned to the spotted boy.

The spotted boy was struggling on the floor with his hands, feet and mouth bound.

Impressed by the reunion of her brother and sister, there were tears and a runny nose on the guy's plump face.

"Sister."

Jung Eunho, who glanced at the spot with an indifferent eye, asked.

"Why are you here? Are you here to check if I'm dead?"

"What?

"Don’t come back. This is no place for sister."

A faint sense of rebellion and emptiness coexisted in Jung Eunho's face, who slowly raised his head.

"It's a different situation than when my sister ran away after beating up my father. Do you still think that sister is the boss of the house?"

"Hey, what are you doing now?"

Jung Heewon, taken aback by her brother's bombshell remarks, suddenly looked back at me.

"No, Inho-ssi. This... it's not that."

I smiled and shook my head as a sign of ok.

Looking at the situation, I seemed to know what had happened.

Of course, children shouldn't hit their parents.

However, I also thought that if someone like Jung Heewon had done such a thing, there must have been a reason.

Jung Heewon sighed lightly and asked.

"So. Where is daddy now?"

"Dad."

Jung Eunho hesitated for a moment before saying with a sigh.

"He’s in the Beggar Sect."

"Beggars?"

"That's the name of the organization I belong to."

"It's strange."

"That person is not a person who will readily join any organization. How's the army doing? What about the apartment people? Dad was a soldier. There must have been subordinates."

At the word 'military', Jung Eunho’s eyes flashed a dark light.

"All caught in the Beggar Sect."

"My father is not a man to be easily caught."

"My original dad would have done that."

Original dad. The nuances in those words were peculiar. However, Jung Eunho's continued words were even more bizarre than that.

"It's as if he is already dead. He's not my dad anymore."

Not his dad?

"The world was destroyed, and the sick suddenly became like a different person."

"What do you mean? Did that person hit you again?"

"No. It's not like that."

The figure of Jung Eunho sighing lightly with Jung Heewon was like a brother and sister.

"Daddy went mad all of a sudden."

"Crazy?"

For a moment, I thought I knew what had happened to Jung Heewon's family.

Jung Eunho, who slowly turned his head toward the window, saw the ruined apartment building in his eyes.

It rained.

Traces of the scenario that left this world in ruins.

However, it may not be the scenario that destroyed Jung Heewon's family.

"Did the novel become a reality, or was it impossible for something like this to happen... He said strange things. Until then, I just thought that my father had gone out of his mind for a moment."

The scenario was brutal, but at least kind.

Like a visitor who rang a doorbell, he introduced who he was, told them what was to come, and taught them what to do.

But he also had unfriendly guests.

Those who came to this world without any kindness or knocks.

"But when the scenario started and I met dad again, dad abandoned me and ran away alone. I cried and chased after him, but I will never forget what my dad said then."

His face rubbed against the cracked veranda window.

I turned my gaze completely to see the boy's face smoldering on the edge of the glass.

A boy wearing a skull mask.

"Everybody saw him."

A boy who had lost all of his family's history in an instant was talking.

"He said he had to find 'Kim Dokja' from now on."

Apparently, a 'reader' possessed Jung Heewon's father.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 630 Episode 15 Doorbell (3)

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"Kim Dokja?"

Hearing the words 'Kim Dokja', Jung Heewon glanced back at me.

She must have remembered me and the other apostles saying that name.

「Jung Heewon doesn't know that we are possessed.」

Jung Heewon only knows that the apostles and I know the 'future'.

But she, too, seemed to have noticed our quirks, instinctively.

He said, "Do you know that name?"

At her brother's question, Jung Heewon shook her head.

"No, just. Did Dad say anything else?

"Even I don't remember everything. Things like knowing the future, saying that this world is about to end... There's no time to take care of me, so he told me to survive alone somehow. The uncle from the next door and the soldiers from the house below also followed my dad. Do you remember Sergeant Kim and Sang Hyun? In fact, some of my dad's predictions were right."

I thought about a reader possessing Jung Heewon's father.

That, too, would be the result of trying to live elsewhere.

There was no way he could have realized that he was someone's father when he was suddenly thrown into the world of a novel while reading it.

Even so, the boy in front of him lost his father because of it.

Kim Dokja once said something like that.

Great destruction is not the only destruction. What really kills someone is a small destruction.

Perhaps, for me and the readers possessing this place, it may already be a disaster for the natives of this world.

"Then, in the second scenario, he was caught by the Beggar Sect. I haven't seen him again since. I heard that he was locked in the basement of Seoul Station…"

Jung Heewon's father struggled hard in his own way, but in the end it seemed that he was defeated by the indigenous forces.

Perhaps it was a natural result.

Even this is an area that is not even properly introduced in Omniscient Reader.

It was a miracle that he managed to pass the first scenario and survive.

Jung Heewon asked.

"So, why are you in the Beggar Sect? You said they took dad? But why are you under that organization..."

Seeing Jung Eunho hesitant to answer, Jung Heewon's eyes narrowed.

"You can't."

"Because that kind of dad is also my dad. I don't abandon my family like my older sister."

In a voice tinged with faint anger, Jung Eunho continued to speak.

"Maybe one day his memories will come back. Maybe being my dad again might not be such a good thing."

Only then did Jung Heewon, who understood her younger brother's words, click her tongue.

"So you went in there and killed and looted other people? Are you really sane?"

"It was the only way. Sister must have killed someone to survive the first scenario."

Only choice to survive.

Who can confidently refute this scenario in front of the boy's justification?

"Me and everyone else here. They're all just struggling to survive."

The children knelt down and huddled in the back while sobbing.

"Sorry. Please forgive me."

"I won't. I won't do that anymore."

I know that it’s a lie.

If we leave, the children will plunder and kill people again using the message of the 'White Flag' as bait.

Jung Heewon sighed lightly and asked.

"Where's the flag?"

Then Jung Eunho sighed as well and pointed to the master bedroom.

"There."

The looting of the children ended here.

The children also bowed their heads as if they knew that fact.

"Look after the children. The next time they get caught, I’ll really kill them."

With her warning, the children's shoulders trembled.

As Jung Eunho said, when I opened the door to the master bedroom, I saw a white-colored flag planted in the center of the room.

[You found a hidden white flag.]

Taking that, we can now create a new group.

"Hey! Stop it! You can’t take that away, you all go for it!"

It was the spotted boy wriggling on the floor who said those words. The boy shouted desperately as if he had managed to remove the towel put on his mouth, and the boy exclaimed desperately.

"Stop! Stop it quickly!"

"Wonshik-ah."

"Shut up! You ten years old!" cried the struggling, agitated spotted boy.

"Release this right now. I'm going to kill you. Have you forgotten who my father is? Do you guys think everything will be alright? Hey! Jung Eunho!"

"Wonshik. Let go of this once. She’s my sister."

"What are you saying, because she’s your sister?"

Unheard of by Jung Eunho, he urged Jung Heewon.

"Sister. If you're going to take it, take it quickly. In a little while, people will come up."

"Who will come?"

"I don’t know who they are, but it’s the Beggar Sect’s place here. Wonsik has already called the beggars. Even if he looks like that, that bastard is the son of Ark and in charge here."

"It doesn't matter who comes."

"I know that you are strong, but... It is impossible for even you to deal with the entire Beggar Sect. And Ark is a really ridiculously strong person. He is truly a master of martial arts that can fly through the sky."

A real martial artist.

I suddenly became curious.

It's not some kind of Yoo Joonghyuk, and common sense says that there wouldn't be such an incarnation at this time.

Why are there Murim people in Korea in the first place?

"Inho-ssi."

I was troubled.

Curiosity aside, it was not the right choice to collide with them here.

We have two purposes for coming here.

One is to find the 'mad butcher'.

The second is to get the white flag.

At the point where the 'Mad Butcher' was presumed to be the younger brother of Jung Heewon, we could see that our goal had already been achieved.

"Let's take the flag first."

"Inho-ssi should take it."

"Are you okay though?

"Anyway, I don’t even know how to use it."

This time, I did not refuse Jung Heewon's concession.

This is because the flag was an item that must be obtained in order to perform the 'King's Road' scenario.

"Then I will have it."

It was the moment when I entered the living room with Jung Heewon that I got a strange feeling.

The place changed to an achromatic color with a cool sensation.

It was the snowfield.

[The activation conditions for the skill '□□' have been met.]

It's been a while since I've seen it.

Time stopped. I reflexively looked around, but I didn't see anything strange. Jung Eunho and the other children did the same.

So what?

It was then that I noticed a red line coming through the crack in the window of the broken room.

A laser scope.

Someone is sniping here.

Fortunately, there were no major concerns.

I had the remaining probability points, and I had the confidence to write a plausible sentence necessary for escape.

Getting out of this kind of crisis...

[The state of the exclusive skill, '□□', is unstable.]

[The 'Snowfield' cannot be activated.]

[The skill is locked.]

What?

The scenery around me changed, and I heard the sound of something being fired in the distance.

Shit.

Reflexively, I hugged Jung Heewon and laid her aside.

But there was someone who moved before me.

"Sister!"

Jung Eunho, who discovered the laser scope, threw his chopsticks in the exact direction where the red line flew.

[Incarnation 'Jung Eunho' activates 'Throw Lv.2'!]

[Incarnation 'Jung Eunho' activates 'Attack Enhancement Lv.2'!]

As soon as the chopsticks were pulled out of the window, the entire building shook with a deafening roar.

It was no ordinary sniping.

Someone fired an anti-battery rocket that was at least equivalent to an RPG.

When we barely opened our eyes in the acrid dust, we could see the landscape of the horribly broken inner room.

The frames of the broken windows were jagged, and the floor of the soft master bedroom on the window side was completely smashed.

On the roof of the building on the opposite floor, we saw a sniper aiming at us. The moment our eyes met, I was startled.

It was a familiar face.

「"Chew, the deployment manager told me to keep an eye on the corner of the road to expand Bunta's power. That's really it. I didn't mean to hurt you!"」

Before coming here, the sniper, who had been released near Chungmuro, made it impossible to speak about us due to the [Oath of Existence], so he decided to kill us instead of returning to Seoul Station.

It was a mistake.

I wasn't letting go of him by trusting a clumsy [Oath of Existence].

"Heewon-ssi, it’s okay."

Red light flowed from Jung Heewon's whole body after shaking off the dust.

She was looking at her own brother who had fallen to the floor.

Jung Eunho collapsed while holding onto his stomach.

I quickly checked Eunho's wound and stopped the bleeding. His bullets must have been poisonous, and the skin that the shrapnel passed through was stained with a dark red

light.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' activates 'Ghost Slayer Lv.4'!]

Jung Heewon ran downstairs like a roaring master.

Shortly thereafter, screams rang out from the ground in the opposite building.

"Uh-uhh-!"

A completely different movement than when dealing with the children. As their limbs were severed and blood spurted out, the man roared at her.

"Here, here! Kuaaaa!"

As if they had already called in reinforcements, dozens of beggars appeared near the entrance of the apartment. It looks like a reinforcement who ran after receiving [group chatting].

Jung Heewon's eyes, burning red due to the effect of [Ghost Slayer], looked back.

It was then that a barrage of bullets flew from somewhere.

Doo doo doo!

Threatening shots directly directed at the beggars.

"Aagh!"

The beggars who had been hit by the bullets were frightened and secretly bit the battle line, and soon a signal was sent.

"Retreat!"

Let's lead the dead beggars and quickly retreat out of the apartment.

A group of our soldiers appeared on the road leading to the underground parking lot.

"Stop shooting!"

All of them must have been camping for a long time, their faces guilty.

Jung Heewon, who had just finished off the sniper, landed on the first floor of the apartment. The moment the soldiers and Jung Heewon were about to engage in a fierce

confrontation, a man came forward when he called the soldiers from the front.

It was a man with a red flag tucked in his waist.

"You... aren't you Jung Heewon?"

Jung Heewon's eyes softened a little as she looked back at the man.

"Sergeant Kim?"

---

The group of soldiers was the remaining troops led by Jung Heewon's father, Jung Moonho.

They said that they were carrying out guerrilla activities to rescue Jung Moonho, who had been captured by the Beggar Sect, and were wandering around the apartment where Jung Heewon was staying.

"You're alive. I'm so glad."

Sergeant Kim held onto Jung Heewon's hand with one hand and wiped his eyes several times.

"Sorry. Mr. Jung is..."

"I've heard about it."

Jung Heewon withdrew her hand with a confident face and immediately asked the necessary question.

"How is Eunho?"

He was shot by the sniper.

Jung Eunho was still unconscious.

Although I hurriedly fed him with 'Ellain Forest's Spirit' and applied short-changing medicine, it wasn't a wound that could be healed to that extent.

A medic had been attached to him since earlier, supplying him with a constant supply of mana.

However, as time passed, Jung Eunho's complexion only worsened.

"Sorry. I don't think he'll be able to survive today at this rate." The voice of a helpless medic.

My thoughts were similar.

For a wound like this, he needed to borrow the help of someone like Lee Seolhwa or use Murim's elixir.

Even if it wasn't Shaolin's Great Rejoice, it was a wound that could only be healed with a summons level.

[This product is out of stock.]

Is this out of stock again?

I searched the 'dokkaebi bag' and looked for other elixirs.

If it's a summons level, there should still be quite a few products.

[This product is out of stock.]

[This product is out of stock.]

All of them were out of stock, as if they had made a promise.

Come to think of it, even Kim Dokja in the main story rarely purchased elixirs through the 'Dokkaebi bag'.

Usually, these elixirs are occupied by incarnations with a constellation of narrative grade or higher as their background.

The ambiguous level of elixirs are already used by constellations who want to raise their incarnation.

After flipping through the purchase pages for a long time, I was able to find a low-grade elixir.

| |
|---|
| *Mine Team - Inventory 3 |

After reading the description, I found that it is a replica of 'Mahondan', one of the three great elixirs of <The 1st Murim>.

First of all, it bothers me that it is a replica, but if it has the same side effects as the real Mahondan, that is also a problem.

「If you eat it as it is, you'll get choking fever and all the blood vessels in your body will burst and you will die.」

This is because Yoo Joonghyuk had made this warning in Omniscient Reader.

In other words, if this is fed incorrectly, Jung Eunho will end up bleeding from poison rather than being cured.

"There is no way right now. I wonder if the blessings of the constellations are there?"

Listening to the medic's words, I stared blankly up at the sky.

The sky, which would normally have been noisy, became deserted today.

Damn, I think there were still a lot of viewers when Yoo Joonghyuk was there.

There might be constellations watching, but I knew without asking that they wouldn't help this boy.

A star who would sacrifice his probability to bring back a boy they had nothing to do with does not exist.

The only thing worth looking forward to was his sponsor, but no matter how I looked at it, Jung Eunho seemed to have no sponsor.

"Inho-ssi."

"I'm thinking about it."

What is needed to save Jung Eunho is the 'Summoning Squad'-class medicine.

If I cannot purchase it from the 'Dokkaebi bag' and cannot expect support from the constellations, there is no other option than to visit <Murim> directly.

However, the minimum condition to enter <Murim> is to acquire a 'Personal Scenario' after breaking through the 10th scenario.

In other words, it was impossible to do anything as of now.

However.

That <Murim>. Maybe it's closer than I think.

"You there."

I called the children who were trembling in the corner.

"Is it true that there is a Murim master in the Beggar Sect?"

"Is there a master of Murim?"

"I heard he flies in the sky and uses martial arts?"

"Ah! That's right!"

The children looked at each other and nodded.

Then Sergeant Kim, who had been listening to the story, spoke up.

"It's true. There are people like that."

"Are you sure?"

"I've even seen them fight. Especially Ark and the three below are monsters. Those farmers dealt with monsters with their bare hands and smashed dunks with their fists. Bullets don't work at all. Our unit was also devastated by the beggars."

A person who could tear monsters to shreds with his bare hands and not work as a gunsmith could definitely be called a Murim man. It is also of a high level.

With common sense, I can’t understand why there are such people in the current scenario.

I didn’t, but…

"They might know how to cure Eunho."

"Let’s go to them right now."

Jung Heewon spoke with the momentum that would destroy <The 1st Murim> as well.

"If you go, you will fight."

"I'm going to fight."

Certainly, Jung Heewon was strong.

It's because she's strong enough to hunt even 7-th grade monsters by herself.

However, the opponent was not a monster, but a human, and even a group.

"Heewon-ssi! You must never go. If you go, you will definitely die. Sergeant Jung was also caught in the same way. Those guys aren’t human."

Sergeant Kim said in a terrified voice.

Jung Heewon made an impression.

"I can't give up Eunho like this. If no one goes, I'll go alone."

Right. That's Jung Heewon, but I can't leave her like that.

"Let's negotiate."

"Negotiation?"

"We can hand over our hostages and get what we want."

At the word hostage, the children's shoulders trembled.

Jung Heewon asked.

"Do they care about the hostages? They're only kids."

"At least one will care."

I watched the spotted boy crawling on the floor behind them.

"You there. You said you were the son of Ark, right?"

I remembered Jung Eunho's words.

["Even if you look like that, that is the son of Ark. He’s in charge here."]

Then the trembling spotted boy shouted.

"I, I, I can't! Oh, if I go to Daddy, I'll die. Please. Please."

I slapped him on the back of his neck and stunned him, then lightly put him on my shoulder. I don't know why this guy is so afraid, but anyway.

"Let's go to Seoul Station."

Even if it wasn't because of Jung Heewon's younger brother, I had to go to Seoul Station.

[You have become an unknown representative!]

The Beggar Sect.

An unknown group occupied the Seoul Station area at the same time as the scenario started.

Seeing that they did not appear in the 'absolute throne'’s war of 'Omniscient Reader', they are probably a group that was wiped out while fighting other kings.

By who? I don't know that.

But one thing is for sure.

[Currently, your target station is 'Seoul Station'.]

Even in this 41st turn, their end will not be very different.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 631 Episode 15 Doorbell (4)

To put it simply, the Beggar Sect is the name of the organization where beggars gathered.

Usually, in martial arts novels, they are regarded as a group that symbolizes the best information power.

There was no way to know how it was described in 'Ways of Survival'.

So, all the way to Seoul Station, I repeatedly turned the skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' off and on.

[Deactivates the exclusive skill, 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World']

[Activates the exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'.]

If you look at it like this, you never know how the skill would react.

How many times did I repeat the same thing like that?

[The skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' is irritated.]

The skill finally responded.

It was a bit of a strange reaction, though.

「...In the early days, the Beggar Sect was one of the strong organizations as one of the old sects of Murim, but it was swept away by the scenario area of the <Star Stream> and tilted a lot...」

Even the contents of Ways of Survival related to the Beggar Sect began to flow.

I think it's a bit deaf, but I wondered where it could be heard.

「New masters who learned the basics of martial arts accurately and quickly through the <Star Stream> quickly took control of Murim, and the 'Beggar Sect' was naturally pushed to the backwaters of the Yangtze River as it was weeded out of the competition.」

Huh. This is a story I know, but the story continued.

「The Beggar Sect, which originally reigned as the old sect of the <1st Murim>, eventually had to move to the <2nd Murim>, and then to the 3rd Murim>, and there are several secret stories related to this.」

Is it the feeling of moving from a large square to a small square?

I read on and on.

「At the time of <The 2nd Murim>'s relocation, the dragon's ark of the Beggar Sect and the elder, Sageol, gathered beggars and made a resolution to engrave the true spirit of Jungwon in a new place.」

Even if it wasn't for the 'little master' who appeared in front of the signboard that day. Also, the three-gyeolgae of the Beggar Sect who rolled the gatekeeper that day made rude remarks after seeing the height of the master. Even if they didn't, their window method would have ended safely.」

Little master?

「On that day, all the doors of the Beggar Sect were opened by the white-blue Kyrgios. The surviving dragon head ark and the elder envoys grabbed the flowing Betga porridge and fled to <The 3rd Murim>.」

The story did not end there.

「After that, the dragon head ark and the envoy led the ruined breakwater and settled down in <The 3rd Murim>. Having lost even the morality of the political faction due to

the shock of Kyrgios, they turned to Sapa, which was ruined anyway, and tried to make a new start.」

Unfortunately, even if the pacheon swordsmen who appeared in <The 3rd Murim> hadn't started 'death swordsmanship', they would have managed to be reborn as useful sappers.」

At this point, I wondered if the place called Beggar Sect was a bit pitiful.

To sum up, it was broken by Kyrgios in the 2nd Murim, and had their sword castle broken in the 3rd Murim...

After that, there is no record of what happened.

I beat the skill and turned it on again to find additional records.

「Yoo Joonghyuk replied as if he was bothered by Kim Namwoon's request. "If you want to know more, find out for yourself."」

An odd sentence came out.

Why are you doing this all of a sudden?

Is it broken?

"What's wrong?"

Jung Heewon asked with worried eyes as if my expression was strange.

I added quickly.

"It's nothing."

I thought that perhaps the 'Beggar Sect of the Murim area' could be related to the Beggar Sect of this place.

Due to the structure of the scenario, there was little chance of real Murim people here, but if there were still descendants or related constellations...

I caught a glimpse of the soldiers following us and the children on their backs.

The one I particularly paid attention to was the spotted boy.

Even if the other guys are like that, what is he so afraid of when his father is the ark of the Beggar Sect?

"I can see Seoul Station."

Well, we'll find out soon.

---

Goh Jangwon was sitting on the stair landing of Seoul Station. Looking at the beggars lined up in front of him, the village official wondered why he had become like this.

Age twenty three.

My favorite thing is to read martial arts webcomics.

I have a girl I love.

Apparently, until a few weeks ago, the sentences describing him were those things.

He had taken a leave of absence before enlisting in the military, and was an ordinary college student who was contemplating whether or not to confess to his classmate, whom he secretly had a crush on for three years.

—Uh, I like webtoons too. What do you read?

—I like web novels more than webtoons.

—A web novel?

—Do you know Omniscient Reader?

So, that was the reason he read the novel.

—Omniscient Reader?

—It's Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, a novel I read these days. I read it 8 times.

—I like novels too.

A novel he read to share even more words with the girl he had a crush on.

A week before his enlistment, he went straight through Omniscient Reader from chapter 1 to chapter 551, and the next day he fell asleep with a thrilled heart, delusional that he

would confess to a girl using the words of the novel he had read. He also decided on a message.

"Youngin, we can date, you know?"

And when he opened his eyes again, he was enlisted in the army.

—Gaaaaagh!

Screams and roars of monsters roared everywhere. Gojangwon cried, trembled, barely remembered the story in the novel, and luckily survived..

—Dad. Where are you? Dad!

He threw away the boy who called him daddy.

He felt remorse, but it was restrained for him.

When he suddenly opened his eyes, he was a soldier, an old man in his late 50s, and even a daddy.

There were enemies aiming for him everywhere, and monsters popped out.

It was a daunting situation to protect his own body.

Fortunately, he knew the contents of this novel.

In order to somehow survive, Goh Jangwon recalled the sentences he knew.

Coincidentally, people nearby followed him, and his personal connections worked effectively.

Thanks to this, he became the commander of an army with Mipil's soul.

"I need to meet Kim Dokja."

From the moment he realized his possession in the novel until now, Go Jangwon's goal has been one.

You must meet the main character of this story.

Only then can you get out of this story and can return to reality.

So, the chieftain went around spreading information that he knew the future.

It was because of the calculation that Kim Dokja would surely return.

—You know the future?

However, there were people who came to him before Kim Dokja.

A group that introduced themselves as the Beggar Sect.

ORV is not a martial arts novel, and he wanted something else, but when he woke up, the soldiers who followed him were beaten in an instant by the masters of the Beggar Sect and were in a desperate state.

It was the first time he knew that a staff was such a formidable weapon.

The beggar holding a baton smeared with human blood and flesh placed his hand on the chieftain's shoulder and declared his affiliation.

—This is the place of the 'Beggar Sect' from now on.

Exactly that far, the content of Omniscient Reader Viewpoint was a failure.

"That's why the soldiers took Wonsik with him. He was also shot by a sniper and he's coming this way now."

The beggar prostrated himself in front of him, trembling.

Watching that scene, Go Jangwon felt like he had become an obvious abbreviation in an obvious story.

Before, these villains all ran away because of Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk.

But as of now, there was nothing else I could do.

If you do something stupid, you will be killed by the open ark before you even meet Kim Dokja.

Because this was the place to run away from.

"If it is Wonshik, is it the son of the Ark?"

"Yes!"

"The one to fight."

The assistant manager remembered the spotless little boy who didn't talk dirty.

Come to think of it, he also had a son. Although he wasn't his real son, he was the son of the person he possessed.

"Sergeant Jung Munho."

"What happened to that guy?"

When he thought of the boy who was running towards him, he belatedly felt guilty.

He wasn't ignoring the boy back then.

It was then that the shouts of beggars were heard from the entrance of Seoul Station.

"They're here!"

He could hardly guess who the people who came were.

Probably his subordinates, Sergeant Kim and the remaining troops.

Kidnapping the son of the ark must have been done out of anger, and it was highly likely that he had come to apologize.

Soon after, soldiers with familiar faces appeared.

"Sergeant Jung!"

"Chief Kim."

It was these guys too.

Go Jangwon… No, Jung Munho opened his mouth with the expression of a newly solemn Sergeant Jung.

"Long time no see."

"Are you okay? You must have been caught by the Beggar Sect-"

"I'm fine. More than that, do you have the son of the Ark?"

"Yes? Yes."

"Then give him back quickly and stop fighting."

"Yes?"

"It's scary when the ark gets angry. Didn't you see it too? They are masters who fly in the sky and beat people like dogs. We can't help it."

Sergeant Kim looked at Jung Munho and stuttered.

"Munho, did you really enter the Beggar Sect?"

Jung Munho nodded heavily.

"Okay. Come in here before it's too late. I have already prepared a place for you myself."

"How, no matter how…"

"Shouldn't people live and see? It's the yard where the president and the prime minister both died. Don't burn useless patriotism, and plan for the future here with me."

“No, why did you change your tone again!"

"My tone..."

He was going to tell him that if he were tortured by the Murim people for three nights and four days, this would happen, but there was someone who stepped forward, bypassing Sergeant Kim.

The moment he wondered who the striking woman with long hair and long swords was, a deep part of his chest was tingling and painful. Clearly he knew that woman. Not exactly him, but his previous body knew her.

"Dad. What are you doing there?"

Looking closely, behind the woman was the boy who called him daddy a while ago.

His stomach was rumbling, and his head was dizzy. What should he say?

Is he the reader Goh Sangwon or the character Jung Moonho? Why do they call him daddy and he should feel guilty?

"Hey, what's going on?"

A group of beggars were coming out of Seoul Station. Jung Moonho, who identified the leading beggar among them, jumped up from his seat.

They must not meet with the samurai.

"Heewon-ssi. Wait a minute."

It was then that a man stepped forward.

A man with a strangely smiling face in a white coat. The moment he looked into his eyes, Jung Moonho thought of his unrequited love, Lee Youngin, and a novel she liked, and he remembered a character drawn on the cover of the novel.

"Hey, hello. You're Heewon-ssi's father."

Exactly as he imagined.

Jung Moonho blankly listened to the man with his mouth open.

"If there is the Ark inside, please tell me."

It must have been.

"The disciple of Baek Cheongmoon came to visit."

Kim Dokja, whom he had been waiting for, finally came to the Beggar Sect.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 632 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (1)

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「"I'm not a mad butcher. But someone has to wear this mask. People want it."」

—The Mad Butcher

---

To begin with, my party and I bloodlessly entered Seoul Station without any restraint.

The open-air Seoul Station building had collapsed in the center and the ceiling was flat.

Perhaps a flying monster had appeared, or that something had fallen from the sky.

"Let's talk for a minute."

The one who guided us was Sergeant Jung Moonho, the father ofJung Heewon, who is now a guardian of the Beggar Sect.

He left the rest of the party at the shelter and led me to a small room inside the shelter.

"You worked hard to get here."

"No."

I don't know if my bluffing as a disciple of Baek Cheongmoon worked.

The only thing that is certain is that just before the Beggar Sect and I collided, Sergeant Jung Moonho and I intervened.

"First of all, I did not pass on the words of 'a disciple of Baek Cheongmoon' that you mentioned earlier to the upper ranks."

Jung Munho, who started the topic with those words, looked outside with nervous eyes.

"If you do that, we will start a real war, you know?"

A real war.

I don't know what kind of person Jung Moonho was in reality.

But with this, I can get a little idea of what kind of person our reader is.

[Exclusive skill 'List of Reader Comments' is activated!]

| |
|---|
| ID: rhwkd1123 |
| Platform: Series |
| Total number of comments: 2 |
| Reader Level: 4 |
| Number of complete readings: 1 time |

I knew it.

The father of Jung Heewon was a reader.

That's also a reader who read the novel completely 1 time.

However, this person managed to read only once and live up to this point.

Maybe it's because I've only seen monsters like Killer King and Ye Hyunwoo, but those who read one time look cute now.

What kind of words did he use?

It wasn't difficult to check because there were only two comments anyway.

> I'm enlisting soon, so will I be able to read it all?
>
> —Recommended 0/ Disliked 0
>
> (Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 1)

He read this novel right before enlisting?

So, was this person possessed prior to enlistment?

I thought he was a little pitiful, but when I thought about it, he was better than being possessed just before being discharged.

I also read the following comments.

> I read this novel because of the girl I like. I'm going to confess tomorrow.
>
> —Recommended 4/ Disapproved 3
>
> (The omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, chapter 551)

I seemed to know roughly what was going on.

To sum it up, he was going to confess to a girl he liked right before he enlisted, but he suddenly possessed a character in a novel that the girl was reading. It does feel the same.

"Isn't there already a war?"

But unfortunately, the world he possessed was not a suitable place for such a sweet title.

"Capture the Flag is such a scenario. People won't hesitate to fight with each other. They'll do anything to get what they want. That's acceptable in this world."

Saying it with my own mouth. I also thought that a lot has changed in that short time.

Only three scenarios made me this way.

Now, without using [Incite], I can state the reality shamelessly like Cheon Inho.

"The strong group will exploit the weak group, and the defeated group will be subjugated. People will die endlessly, and the scenario will flow. It becomes a world of entertainment, and the stars shine in the sky.

[The constellation 'The Prisoner of the Golden Headband' says that's the scenario.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' knows that anyone can ascend if they do not give up until the end.]

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier smiles bitterly.]

For the stars who have lived in the world of scenarios, this logic is very natural.

But to the reader who was at peace until a month ago, this will not be the case.

"I, I, I can't. I can't watch people die anymore. This thing, this thing is so ridiculous."

Sergeant Jung Munho must have witnessed his subordinates being brutally beaten by the masters of Beggar Sect right in front of his eyes.

He must have felt that he would struggle to live. He would have made a choice he didn't want.

"Did you hide in the Beggar Sect because you were afraid of that?"

"It's not because I want to fight either. I..."

Sergeant Jung Munho shivered as he wrapped his arms around his shoulders.

I looked at him blankly and said.

"Slowly tell me what you really want to say."

"Yes?"

"Didn’t you set [Block sound wave] at most? Is there anything else you want to say?"

This is the place where 'block sound wave' is activated.

He must have something to say to me before the open ark finds out about this.

Jung Munho looked at my face blankly, and suddenly started to shed tears.

I said a little flustered.

"Don’t cry."

"Do you know how hard it was for me?"

Not all readers adapt to this world as brilliantly as Killer King or Ye Hyunwoo.

There were probably many more readers than that, and they would have died. And most of the survivors are probably in the same condition as Sergeant Jung Munho in front of them.

Sergeant Jung Munho, who managed to swallow his tears, asked in a trembling voice.

"K-Kim, Kim Dokja... is that right?"

"Yes?"

In an instant, I realized what misunderstanding he had.

Wait for a sec.

But how can such a misunderstanding be possible?

I didn't really use [incite], and I didn't even use 'Ever-changing Stealth Suit' with 'Thought'.

"Mmm, I knew it right away the moment I saw you from a distance. The white coat and the darkly smiling eyes! Plus the courage to confidently lie that you're a disciple of that man..."

"Uh…"

"You look a little different from the one on the cover, but... The cover of a novel is originally drawn differently from the truth. But was your hair color originally that flashy?"

The moment I saw Sergeant Jung Munho's earnest eyes, I realized what state he was in.

「However you look at it, I wasn’t Kim Dokja.」

Different hair styles and different appearances Even though my outfit is similar, it's easy to see that I'm not Kim Dokja after a little observation.

A reader who had read the novel properly couldn’t have not known it.

「But Jung Munho thought I was Kim Dokja.」

That's exactly what he decided to think.

For him, it was because I had to be 'Kim Dokja'. He lost the world he lived in while experiencing a sudden possession, and saw countless deaths. He lost his subordinates and abandoned even the children who called him father.

In order to survive, he betrayed his remaining comrades and surrendered to the enemy.

Somehow he managed to maintain a barely normal life, but that was the limit.

He was completely broken inside, and he needed someone to tell him that all this tragedy that beset him now was 'fake'.

He said he did nothing wrong, so let's get out of this terrible abuse.

A magic word that will return him to the position of 'Kim Dokja'. He wanted to hear that word from 'Kim Dokja'.

I slowly opened my mouth while looking at my reader.

"Jung Munho, please listen carefully to what I will say from now on."

Instead of telling him that I wasn't Kim Dokja, I briefly explained to Jung Munho what was happening in the world right now.

It was because he seemed to know nothing.

"T-there are other readers besides me who are possessing characters?"

Jung Munho, who opened his eyes wide, muttered 'Youngin' in a dazed voice, then suddenly raised his head and asked.

"Then have you met other readers?"

“Of course I saw them. Weren’t you invited to Kim Dokja's banquet too?"

"What banquet?

"Hosted by a guy named 'RepresentativeKimDokja'..."

"RepresentativeKimDokja? Who is that? Does he represent Kim Dokja?"

Judging by the look on his face, it didn't look like he was lying.

I wondered if there might be some readers who were not invited to the banquet, but Sergeant Jung Munho suddenly said with a small exclamation.

"Well, come to think of it, I've had dreams of going to the cinema all of a sudden..."

He must have been summoned while sleeping.

"Was that not a dream?"

"Yes, it's not a dream."

Sergeant Jung Munho, whose complexion was bluish, touched his face.

"So what am I going to do now? Do I have to live here?"

Was he going to die of old age after becoming a military grandfather?

Watching Jung Munho shed tears, a part of my heart felt salty.

If someone asks if this man is innocent, I can't help but nod my head in conviction. Anyway, he killed people, and he even ruined Jung Heewon’s younger brother...

"I-I now..."

I held onto the shoulders of Sergeant Jung Moonho, who was crumbling.

"Calm down. Please stop crying."

"Yes. Yes."

"Jung Munho, listen to me carefully from now on."

I am not Kim Dokja.

Therefore, I would not be able to do what Kim Dokja did.

"Soon there will be blood in this station. If the conversation goes well, it may not happen, but there is a very high chance that it will not work out."

But at least, wouldn't it be possible to save one reader in crisis?

"Shit, are you going to fight? But you're still in the early stages. You're not even a constellation yet. The open ark is really strong."

"Don't worry, I'll take care of that."

Looking at Sergeant Jung Munho's swaying eyes, I activated [Incite].

"Jung Munho doesn't have to fight anymore. He doesn't have to kill people or face monsters. Jung Munho just needs to play one role."

"That. What is that role?"

"Jung Heewon and Jung Eunho's father."

Sergeant Jung Munho paused at my words. And exactly after 10 seconds, he spoke up.

"I-is it Jung Heewon? Jung Heewon? That Jung Heewon?"

It seems he didn't know anything either.

"Yes, it's that Jung Heewon."

"Then what should I do now?"

Perhaps Sergeant Jung Munho of this turn was destined to die by Jung Heewon's sword.

But fortunately, 'Jung Munho' is a fake, and since he is a fake, there must be things that can be done.

"Do your best to be a 'good father'."

"A good dad?"

"Yes."

"That... how am I supposed to do it? I'm not married yet…"

A good father.

I don't know that either.

Such a story does not come out properly in 'Ways of Survival' or 'Omniscient Reader'.

I remembered the memories of Lee Hakhyun's days.

The people who made me, who had always wandered without being able to apply it to reality, live as 'Writer Lee Hakhyun'.

My parents, who helped me to turn a child's delusion into a work of art.

"No matter what she does, praise her for doing well."

---

While Sergeant Jung Munho practiced saying 'Good job' into the air, a rather unpleasant atmosphere began to flow in Seoul Station.

Hearing all the gossip everywhere, I feel like something is going to happen soon.

One of the members of the Beggar Sect that had been wandering from afar came up to me and asked.

"Are you a disciple of Baekcheongmun or something?"

Sergeant Jung Munho's face turned white at that question.

My words, which he did not report, seemed to have spread among the beggars.

The Beggar Sect seems to also be the best information power here.

"Follow me. The Ark is looking for you."

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 633 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (2)

Anyway, since I came this far, I had to meet the ark of the Beggar Sect.

Our goal is to find a cure for Jung Eunho.

If this place is really the Beggar Sect of Murim, no matter how degraded it may be, there will be some useful spirits.

Jung Heewon said.

"Let's go together."

"I'm going alone now. Please take care of Eunho in the meantime."

"If anything happens, call me right away, you know?"

I nodded.

If it was normal, of course I would have moved with Jung Heewon.

But this time it was difficult.

Because now I'm someone’s disciple, and Kyrgios's disciple isn't frightened by the Beggar Sect.

[NOTE 1]

"I'll take this guy with me."

I said, pointing at the spotted boy, our hostage.

The guy seemed to have resigned himself, but now he was in a compliant state.

"Go all the way over there."

At the end of the opening, I started walking along the path to the waiting room.

It was then that the spotted boy on my back opened his mouth.

"Mister."

"Uh."

"It's useless even if you take me. A person like me is worthless as a hostage."

I paused, then put the spotted boy on the floor and untied the knots from his hands and feet.

The puzzled boy looked up at me.

"Are you freeing me?"

I replied with a grin.

"You said you weren't worth being a hostage."

"I. Can I run away?"

"Do you want to?"

The spotted boy bowed his head.

After all, this boy knows it too. There is no place in this world for children to run away to.

Scenarios are hell everywhere.

The only thing this boy who didn't have great abilities could do was to dig a trap using his fucked up appearance.

"Your father, I heard that person suddenly changed."

The startled boy raised his head.

"How has it changed? Please explain."

"Just. All of a sudden, he was a completely different person."

"His appearance has changed?"

"His appearance is the same. The behavior of the homeless is the same."

The boy hesitated and continued.

"My dad was homeless, but he wasn't a bad guy. He ruined his business and went bankrupt and lost all of his money, but he wasn't one to hurt anyone."

The closer he got to the waiting room, the more the spotted boy stuttered.

"It all changed by touching that strange stone…"

Strange stone?

Soon after, the waiting room at Seoul Station, covered with a huge cloth, appeared.

It looked as if a relief camp had been set up in the center of Seoul Station.

Therein lies the Ark of the Beggar Sect.

I went inside and into the tent with the shivering spotted boy.

In the center of the tent, there was a huge stone on the floor, and just below the stone were the tables and chairs of the broken waiting room.

The ark of the Beggar Sect was sitting in one of the chairs drinking tea.

As if someone is enjoying this cataclysmic time leisurely.

Even knowing that I had appeared in the tent, he continued to sip his tea without being conscious of me.

"There's something strange about the tea here."

Then the four beggars who were guarding him bowed their heads.

"The tea I used to know doesn't taste like this."

"I'm sorry. That was all I could get here."

"It can't be helped."

The Ark sniffed once again.

"Just as the Murim we remembered has disappeared, the scent of the tea that people talk about has changed."

I felt like I was suddenly in the middle of a martial arts novel.

Obviously, the place and time are different. This place was far from Murim.

Even so, the moment he opened his mouth, this place became Murim.

No matter where he is, he is a being who can change the scenery around him with just his words.

"Don't stand there, come over and sit down. Welcome to the Beggar Sect."

This place is truly the 'Beggar Sect'.

I felt that way all over again.

"Excuse me."

I sat on the opposite side of the ark with a nonchalant look.

As I sat down, Ark asked, sipping a sip of tea.

"Why did you bring that child?"

The spotted boy who caught his gaze shook his shoulders.

I said as I lightly wrapped my arms around the child's shoulders.

"Ah. A hostage."

"Hostage?"

After all, no matter how you look at it, it wasn't the way he looked at his own child.

I added a word.

"You have a brave son."

Only then did the Ark's eyes change.

The Ark looked at the spotted boy carefully and said.

"All the children of the Beggar Sect are brave. Even with their grandparents and begging for food on the street, they take care of themselves."

"..."

"I don't know what you expected, but I don't think I'm going to give you any special treatment just because you're my son. From the moment you enter this group, the distinction between a child and an adult is meaningless. We're just beggars living under the same sky as a roof."

I said while holding the spotted boy's shoulder.

"Beggars are children, and adults are adults."

"From the point of view of the universe, the two are not very different."

It was a plausible statement to hear.

But that was not something that could be said from a human's point of view.

"From a star’s point of view, that might be the case."

The spotted boy said that his father suddenly became 'another person'.

[Exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

**<Character information>**

Name: Myung Sewoon

Age: 44

Sponsor: The Last Ruler

Exclusive Attributes: Homeless (Normal), Murim (Rare)

Exclusive Skills: [Camping Lv.3], [Fishing Lv.3], [Verse Lv.3]...

Stigma: [Punching stick Lv.3]...

Overall stats: [Stamina Lv.25], [Strength Lv.25], [Agility Lv.25], [Magic Power Lv.25]

Comprehensive Evaluation: This person acts as a proxy for the will of the last ruler.

An incarnation with decent overall abilities.

However, what really bothered me was the comprehensive evaluation, not the comprehensive ability.

「A proxy of the constellation's will is.」

Is it some kind of possession? But can it?

There's no way a constellation-class existence could possess an incarnation from the beginning of the scenarios.

I tested my luck.

"Why is a constellation here? The last ruler. This place is not Murim."

Constellation 'The Last Ruler'.

If the record of 'Ways of Survival' is correct, the Beggar Sect was kicked out of Murim after being defeated by Kyrgios and the Pajeon Swordsman in <The 2nd Murim> and <The 3rd Murim>.

Then, the 'last ruler' refers to the last 'Ark' of the Beggar Sect.

There was no mistake.

In other words, what is controlling the incarnation in front of me right now is.

「The leader of the Beggar Sect that became a constellation.」

The Ark completely opened his mouth.

"You are an interesting young man. Did you find out that far already?"

The moment the Ark put the teacup down, the air around him changed.

I knew it instinctively.

The pressure I felt from the Ark right now was at least a '6th-grade monster'.

"Yes, I am the dragon head ark of the Beggar Sect."

Is it an illusion? With that declaration, it really seemed like the signboard of the Beggar Sect could be seen behind him.

Perhaps that is his story.

Murim's prestigious political faction, which has been around for over a thousand years, is the Beggar Sect.

I saw a flag flying behind his back.

A purple flag.

The flag of 'Capture the Flag' starts with white, passes through red, indigo, brown, and purple, and finally ends in black.

However, the ark in front of my eyes obtained a purple flag not long after the scenario began.

I don't know, but all the representatives of the Seoul Station area must have died at the hands of the Beggar Sect.

It's such a horrifying growth that even Yoo Joonghyuk would be wary.

I was genuinely curious.

If he appeared in 'Ways of Survival', then by whom did he change his name?

I spoke calmly.

"I don't understand. Why did you rush into the incarnation's pastime with the stature of a great star?"

In fact, from the existence of the possessed body of the constellation in this initial scenario, the probability of the scenario should not allow this to happen.

"It's a great star. You seem to know a lot about constellations."

The Ark laughed.

"Are you also a being who knows the future?"

I wanted to faint for a moment.

Come to think of it, Sergeant Jung Munho was caught and said that he blew on this and that.

"That friend told me an interesting story. This world is actually in a story, and we are all characters in that story."

No, what are you talking about, dear reader.

"I thought it was an interesting analogy. I've often had similar thoughts."

Fortunately, the famous ark of the Beggar Sect seemed to accept reality as it is as a metaphor.

"If this is really a story, what kind of story will remain of my 'Beggar Sect'? Is the history of the 'Beggar Sect' over now? Is it remembered as a den of mere beggars that is no longer talked about by people?"

It was a voice of deep remorse.

A faint scent wafted from the half-remaining dragon's teacup. It had such a faded scent that it was hard to tell what kind of tea leaves it was made from.

"I just took a chance. A chance to start over again. A chance to stir up the narrative once again and the Beggar Sect to be remembered in the <Star Stream>."

Got a chance. By whom?

Who can provide the probability that the existence of a constellation class can interfere at the beginning of the scenarios?

I don't know.

All I know is that I have to stop this crazy beggar.

"Then you came to the wrong place."

"I also gave up a lot in return. Can you feel the status of a constellation from me now?"

I thought it was strange.

The Ark was obviously strong, but he wasn't comparable to a constellation.

If he really had the status of a constellation, the moment I met him, I would have burst out of my limbs, unable to withstand the pressure of the story.

"Let's get to the main topic. Hey, I heard you're a disciple of Kyrgios."

The Ark's eyes sank coldly. I knew it instinctively. This confrontation is real from now on.

"Can you prove it?"

Of course, I am not his disciple, so there are no mortuary tablets or holy relics to prove it.

But.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.5' is activated!]

Fortunately, I know a real disciple of Kyrgios.

「I am Kim Dokja.」

The moment I thought that sentence, I felt like I had truly become a disciple of Kyrgios.

I was not afraid of anything.

The smallest is the greatest.

And I want to hit Yoo Joonghyuk in the back of the head. Perhaps they felt the atmosphere, and the complexion of the beggars lined up behind the Ark changed.

The last point was [White and Blue Steel], which LiteraryGirl64 passed on to me.

[The exclusive skill 'White and Blue Steel Lv.1' is activated!]

Sensing bluish magic flowing from my body, Ark opened his eyes wide.

He said, "You really were Kyrgios’s disciple."

The beggars who were guarding him from behind were also greatly agitated.

"Really, his apprentice came here... do you know what that means?"

A subtle sense of intimidation spread subtly.

I grinned.

"I know. And I know that my acquaintances have been strengthened through your actions."

"So?"

I wanted to be able to say this.

But my mouth is already out of my control.

Because I was that Kim Dokja now.

"Give me the Summoning Team Sirog."

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is amazed at your spirit.]

Kim Dokja, the living voice of Omniscient Reader.

"Summoning team? Why did you come to the Beggar Sect to find Shaolin's Elixir?"

"If there is no summoning group, the suicide squad or whatever is fine. In any case, give me an elixir that can heal internal wounds."

The ark opened his mouth as if he was dumbfounded by my words.

"Is that all?"

"No, I have one more business."

I also wanted to cover my mouth.

What was in front of my eyes was a crazy constellation turned into a beggar, and my head could burst if I kept talking.

However, I was very firm.

"Give me that flag, too."

Because I was a crazy Kim Dokja now.

"Otherwise, next time our master will find this place himself."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' nods happily.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Let’s change the strange name from before to Kyrgios. Lee Hahkyun is now pretending to be Kyrgios’s disciple.In other words, there is no need for an escort.

# 634 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (3)

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If you don't give me what I want right now, I'll call my master.

At my simple declaration, the stars in the sky could be heard chattering.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' smiles at your courageous spirit.]

[The Constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' nods intriguedly.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks who the teacher is.]

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier makes an interested expression.]

[A constellation sensitive to the fashion of Murim is excited about the return of Kyrgios.]

Of course, everything I said was bullshit.

Because I wasn't really his disciple.

But now I was in a state of [inciting] myself to be Kyrgios's disciple, Kim Dokja, so I was confident in avoiding any [Lie Detection].

But instead of using [Lie Detection], the ark of the Beggar Sect sent me a silent gaze.

"Are you threatening me now?"

"I'm not threatening you, I'm telling you the truth."

"If I don't give you the elixir, will you call Kyrgios?

"I'm sure you didn't hear me, but I'll say it again."

I answered in a high-pitched voice.

"One summoning class elixir and your flag. Please give me both."

"..."

"If that's the case, I think you've enjoyed the early scenarios. At this point, let the incarnations on the stage and return to the audience."

"..."

"The era of the old faction is over. This is not the stage you lived in."

There must have been a change of emotion because of my words, but I didn't see any emotion on the face of the ark of the Beggar Sect.

To be honest, I was a little surprised.

No matter how great a person is, even if they lose all of their status, is a constellation still a constellation?

A being who has built up a story by defeating countless competitors and enduring distant scenarios.

Angry on his behalf were the four men staring at me from behind the ark.

It was the beggars.

Apparently, they also knew the secret story between Kyrgios and the Beggar Sect.

There was a sentence that came to mind out of nowhere.

「There was always an elder 'envoy' by the side of the deployment of the Dragon's Head Ark.」

Maybe they are the things recorded in Ways of Survival.

Apparently, they don't seem to be possessed by a constellation, and if the envoy's story was put in with some kind of secret technique—

"You're Kyrgios's disciple."

As I kept silent, the ark finally opened his mouth.

"I also know that my stage is over. This era is not my era, and the Murim I remembered is nowhere. The Beggar Sect of the most brilliant era was destroyed just before by your proud teacher."

Unexpectedly, he readily acknowledged his situation.

"I'm still afraid of your master. The level he reached will never be reached even if I die and wake up again and again."

I thought of Kyrgios Rodgrim.

「A being born as a mortal and attaining great status after ceaseless diligence. A man who refused the seat of a constellation and achieved transcendence by confronting the sky.」

Although I had never seen him before, just thinking about that sentence gave me a little sense of the despair that the Ark in front of me would have faced.

In an instant, a circuit of hope began to turn in my head.

Maybe with one shot of this lie, I can get the elixir and the flag smoothly.

Could it be?

"But that's why your threats don't work."

Damn, then it is.

"Kyrgios can never come here."

"Why do you think so?"

The Ark smiled. It was a melodious smile that covered the surroundings like unpleasant moss.

"Because he is too strong."

Kyrgios is too strong.

It was a fact I knew too.

Indeed, because of that, Kyrgios couldn't defend 'Peace Land' in the sixth scenario, and had to watch his own planet be destroyed.

"All beings with mighty personalities have powerful stories. However, to intervene in the scenario here, they must let go of the stories they have lived through. But no being in the world dares to make such a choice. Except for me."

Only then did I find the reason why he, who is a great person, can maintain his possession on an incarnation.

I seemed to know.

In order to come here, he sacrificed the stories he had accumulated over many years.

Just as Yoo Joonghyuk chose to regress, the ark laid down all of his history to start the 'scenario' once again.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' grabs his tongue.]

[Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' goes to the place where the children play and asks what the senile Byul is doing.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' shakes his head.]

I could see the fiercely twinkling stars through the open ceiling of Seoul Station.

However, despite the scoldings from the constellations, the ark remained calm.

"That's funny. Are those who are afraid to put down the story they have, and don't have the confidence to create the next story, so they just stay there, have the right to criticize me?

[Some of the historical-grade constellations criticize the attitude of 'The Last Ark'!]

[A small number of great people-class constellations hold their tongues at the idea of 'The Last Ark'!]

"If you are dissatisfied, come down here too. If you have the courage to drop everything you have and start over from the gutter of the scenario."

[The constellation 'two-legged expert' laughs at the guy who doesn't even have a few stories for talking fluently.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' points out that honestly, it's like reincarnation.]

[The constellation 'Flying Dragon' declares that courage is praised, but don't expect coin sponsorship.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband watches the battle of nerves of the great constellations.]

Just as the audience on the stage becomes a spectacle for other spectators, the Ark has now become a prey for other stars.

Still, the Ark was smiling.

As if he was much prouder of himself on the ground than the stars in the sky.

"It's okay to criticize me. I will start anew here. Once again, I will regain the Murim of that time and the Beggar Sect of that time. I am still 'The Last Ruler' and my story will continue here."

[NOTE 1]

Perhaps it is to abandon the status of an omniscient reader and become a character.

It could be something similar.

I heard his story flowing quietly into my ears.

「"Kyrgios. I will meet him again someday, and I will surely be recognized."」

「"The Beggar Sect is still strong. It's not a group weak enough for you to ignore."」

The three waves of history he lived through were felt intact.

A story no one has ever read.

It was the story of an extra who was pushed to the periphery by the main characters of Murim.

「"Why can't we be like them? Why did heaven allow only Kyrgios and Namgung Minyoung to exist in a special way?"」

「"I will become a constellation. I can sell all my martial arts. If only I could stand side by side with the stars in the sky."」

「"Stars of the great nebula. I will gladly become your servant, so please give me the blessing to ascend to the throne."」

Just as Sergeant Jung Munho committed himself to the Beggar Sect to survive, the Ark threw himself into a giant nebula to survive.

But he realized too late that it wasn't the story he wanted.

「"Have you endured that humiliation just to be at this height?"」

He even broke the beliefs of his time as a human and became a constellation. However, when he became a constellation, there was a scenery that could be seen.

Above the historical-grade was the narrative-grade, and above the narrative-grade was the myth-grade.

Even though he had finally risen to the top of the sky, the end of the universe could not be seen.

The Ark, who had lived only looking at the sky, looked down at the ground for the first time at that time.

Becoming a constellation, forgotten human dreams came to mind.

The time when he interacted with and chatted with people who were thrilled by small incidents, thirsty for small enlightenment, and who live at most 100 years. He recalled the dazzling and suffocating mortal history.

"It's amazing."

The ark was watching me.

"Do you understand me? You’re a disciple of Kyrgios."

He was right. I understood him now. As a constellation, he understood another sense of helplessness and the deep emptiness he faced through thorough sentences.

His eyes drew a soft arc at me.

"How can you understand internal narrative, having lived through a short history of only a few decades?"

Words that seemed to have received some kind of consolation.

I laughed bitterly and shook my head.

"I know that threats don't work. You came back here to be that person."

The Ark nodded his head.

"Yes."

"It won't be easy. Just because you put down an enemy, doesn't really mean all the stories you've had are gone."

"What do you mean?"

"Even if you start all over again, the history of losing to my master or the Pacheon Sword Saint will not disappear."

Even if he makes a new Beggar Sect, the stars will not forget the old Beggar Sect.

They would only remember the miserable state of the Beggar Sect, being pushed to the periphery after being defeated by Kyrgios and the Fallen Swordsman.

The ark frowned for the first time.

"I can change it. I can make great achievements here and receive the attention of more stars."

The ark was uplifting like an old actor who was blinded by the scenario.

Certainly, given the circumstances, he deserved his confidence.

He had already achieved the 'Purple Flag' and had the 'King's Road' just around the corner.

The new Beggar Sect has grown steadily with Seoul Station as its base, and has already become an influential group.

But I knew.

「His failure was already recorded.」

He will not be the protagonist of the new world, he will fail to take revenge, and he will be forgotten.

It will be a story no one reads.

"At first, you were told I knew the future."

That's why, I.

[The exclusive spell 'Incite Lv.5' is activated!]

I decided to try what I do best.

"The reborn Beggar Sect will be a win-win in the early scenarios."

At this rate, the Beggar Sect was over.

The star that fell to the ground with a grand meaning will eventually be teased by the constellations and self-inflicted.

Beggars are displaced, only plunder and lies with left.

Children will die brutally to adults who are no longer fooled.

"The Beggar Sect will have an advantage over the other groups and end the 'Capture the Flag', and you will finally follow the 'King's way' and participate in the Battle for the 'Absolute Throne'."

"Of course it is."

As if he knew that, the ark nodded his head.

My story started here.

"But your luck ends there. You, who have to fight as an incarnation, suffer the penalty of not being able to borrow the power of a stronger background. It may seem like you're ahead of other incarnations right now, but before the fight of the Absolute Throne is over, you and the Beggar Sect will reach their limit."

"It can't be. The Constellations participating in this war are only great-"

"Among the participants in the War for the Absolute Throne is the disciple of the Pacheon Sword Saint."

At my words, the eyes of the ark shook profoundly.

"Is that true?"

I nodded and continued.

"You will be defeated by him. The Beggar Sect will fall, and you will end up in pieces. And beheading your broken body is an unknown incarnation waiting for you to fall."

I thought about the Beggar Sect that disappeared without a word in 'Ways of Survival', and imagined the 'mad butcher' who might have been here.

"Like that, the Beggar Sect will perish forever."

"It can't be! You're-"

"If you don't want to face that future, you have one option."

The ark’s eyes trembled. Even if he was calm, he seemed impatient in front of the word extinction.

"Do you mean to bow my head to Kyrgios’s disciple?"

"No."

I said with a grin.

"Do you want to make an alliance?"

"An alliance."

"Pass the flag to me and we'll be a group."

Sparks flew in the eyes of the ark that was blankly staring at me.

"To me now, you dare…"

The waiting room began to vibrate faintly. A spark that bounces thinly. Even though he played around like this, he was still a constellation in the sky.

I cut him off before his anger took over.

"You said you wanted to build a great story that would suit the new Beggar Sect."

I know what he really wanted.

「"Kyrgios. I will meet him again someday and I will surely be recognized."」

The Constellation that wanted to surpass Kyrgios more than anyone else, wanted to be acknowledged by him.

So now he will have a hard time resisting this temptation.

"If you hand over the elixir and flag of Murim that you have to me."

All I can give you is a lie that's nothing.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.5' is activated to the limit!]

But if he believes me.

"The 'disciple of Kyrgios' that brought you down will gladly be defeated by the Beggar Sect here today."

This will be a new story.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: 'Ark' ≈ 'ruler'.A constellation that puts down all their stories and returns to the beginning of the scenarios.

# 635 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (4)

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The disciple of Kyrgios would be willing to lose to the Beggar Sect here today.

That word brought a heavy silence in the waiting room.

The Ark's pupils trembled with deep agitation, and the beggars guarding the back also widened their eyes.

The spotted boy who was sitting next to me holding his breath looked up at me wondering what was going on.

I still do not affirm the 'Beggar Sect'.

Still, I was moved by their stories.

I felt a certain charm in this material that was abandoned without being read properly. At least as a writer who read, wrote, and helped with the sentences of this world, I wanted to write their story because even one line would be good.

The Ark, which pondered the meaning of my words for a long time, asked.

"Will you lose? What does that mean?"

"Let’s fight."

"Fight?"

"Yes. In the way of Murim."

The Ark nodded.

"You mean you're going to lose to us in the fight?"

"I didn't even say that."

The ark narrowed his eyes at my whirling answer.

But looking at me like that won't really look inside me.

Because that's the advantage of a narrow-eyed character.

"What are you…"

The moment the Ark, who had bitten his lips, was about to open his mouth again.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' says it’s an interesting idea.]

The stars of Seoul twinkled.

[The constellation 'Two-Legged Expert' sarcastically says that the Great Beggar Sect will reject the offer.]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' is interested.]

[The constellation 'Marine Admiral' feels nostalgic for old martial arts.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' likes to see the baton method after a long time.]

[The constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says that he also likes martial arts.]

[A few constellations who remember Murim recall the Beggar Sect and the Kyrgios’s fight.]

[A bounty scenario has arrived.]

**<Bounty Scenario - Fight>**

Classification: Sub

Difficulty: C+

Clear condition: Win by fighting against the Beggar Sect that appeared in the 8612 planetary system.

Time limit: 3 hours

Reward: Murim's Lesser Elixir

Failure: —

I saw a scattering of emotions in the Ark's expression, the feeling of being back on this terrible stretcher once again. The feeling of helplessness that the coffin of the stars became a distance. And the old nostalgia that comes from the old tradition of the stars.

Now the table is set, and all that remains is his decision. Counting the stars in the sky, the ark, who had been raising its head in awe, finally opened his mouth.

---

In conclusion, the ark accepted the proposal to fight.

With the constellations even offering a bounty scenario, he must have had no justification for refusing.

"We'll start in five minutes."

While the beggars were pushing the tables and chairs in the waiting room, I was re-reading the bounty scenario I received earlier.

Originally, it was a scenario that I would not have paid much attention to, but this time, the problem was the compensation for the scenario.

The reward for completing the bounty scenario is 'Lesser Elixir'.

The question is to what extent this 'lower' is 'lower'.

If it was a demon-level elixir full of impurities, even if it was received, it could not be used to heal Jung Eunho.

「Perhaps the Ark has a hidden elixir.」

Taking an elixir at the start of a scenario and securing a certain level of magical power is an old cliché in martial arts.

The problem is that getting the elixir from him is much more difficult than simply defeating the Beggar Sect. What would Kim Dokja do?

Perhaps, again, he said plausible nonsense, and the profit was taken as it was, and the Ark flowed to the plate of self-heating by eating the bone.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' expects your strategy.]

I'm not Kim Dokja, so I don't have the confidence to go that far.

I am the author Lee Hakhyun, and in the end, I have to solve this problem in the way of Lee Hakhyun.

"Good job. Good job."

When I turned around in shock, Sergeant Jung Munho was still walking around repeating the same words.

"Reader-nim."

I called Sergeant Jung Munho, thinking it was all right.

Sergeant Jung Munho, startled, looked at me.

"Yes."

He looked like a private in full military discipline.

"I think I need some help from you, reader-nim."

"Are you talking about the father role?"

"Please continue with that. This time, I'm asking you something different."

"What..."

"Are you good at fighting?"

Sergeant Jung Munho quickly hit the hammer, perhaps feeling an ominous feeling.

"It's not good. It's really bad."

"Good."

"Yes?"

"Soon there will be a fighting competition against the Beggar Sect."

"So what?"

"Please, reader-nim, be the first contestant."

"No, I can't fight?"

I said while lightly holding Sergeant Jung Munho's shoulder, who seemed to feel absurd.

"It's okay. You won't die. It's not a matter of life and death, so don't be nervous and try to get hurt as little as possible."

"No, if I lose then—"

"You can lose. Please lose."

"Yes?"

Early on, I saw Jung Heewon, Jung Eunho, and Sergeant Kim's party approaching.

After briefly exchanging glances with Jung Heewon, I looked around the waiting room.

The beggars who had heard the rumors were also gathering in the waiting room one by one.

The Ark stepped forward and said.

"Let’s start slowly."

Finally, the preparations of the beggars were over. A simple stage was installed in the center of the waiting room. The beggar in charge of being the referee went up to the center of the stage. It was about to start.

"There are three players each. It is a one-to-one game, and the first player to win twice wins. Any objection?"

"I don’t."

"You will regret it."

I laughed silently.

The Beggar Sect will do their best.

In order to defeat the proud pupils of Kyrgios and to avenge their past.

"You'll know when you see it."

"The first player on our side is one of the envoys."

After all, the beggars behind the Ark were the 'death'.

"I don't think it's the real deal."

"Yes, you are a sharp child."

Cheongae said as he watched Sageol go up the stage.

"He took the Fragment of the story that I had. I gave him the memory of one of the gangs, the Boggle Dog."

"You know he's not really a braggart."

"I know."

The ark nodded his head, and added after a brief pause.

"But if I believe so, he's a real braggart."

When the beggar in charge of being the referee raised his hand, Jung Moonho, who was in charge of our selection, went up to the main stage.

"The first match begins."

I was curious about the skills Sergeant Jung Moonho had.

Anyway, he is Jung Heewon's father.

Still, he must have at least one useful skill if he survived.

“Now, wait a minute. I really intend to fight him."

The beggar, who said he had received the memory of a braggart dog, rushed at him with a quick sound, ignoring Sergeant Jung Moonho's hand.

"Now, wait! Time!"

The stick he swung in an instant aimed at Sergeant Jung Moonho's head. Embarrassed, Sergeant Jung Moonho hurriedly withdrew his cup and waved his hands. Perhaps the beggar noticed the level of his opponent, but the beggar did not spread a vicious spray.

However, he overwhelmingly made fun of him, and when he was hit, he only picked and hit the sore spot.

"Ah! Aaaagh!"

Every time he was hit, Sergeant Jung Moonho jumped up and down like a rabbit. The beggars giggled at Sergeant Jung Moonho, who was beaten one-sidedly.

When Sergeant Kim cursed at the beggars, the beggars on the other side made mocking gestures.

I glanced back at Jung Heewon.

She silently watched her father fight. With her face devoid of any emotion, she put her hand on the hilt of her sword so she could get out at any moment.

"Ha, surrender! Surrender!"

In less than a minute, Sergeant Jung Moonho, who was black and bruised all over, surrendered.

The referee raised his hand.

"Stop the match! The first fight is the victory of the Beggar Sect!"

When the beggar smiled and lightly waved his stick toward the audience, the beggars onlookers cheered.

I jumped onto the stage and helped Sergeant Jung Moonho, who had fallen.

"Are you okay?"

"Ugh…"

"You're not hurt."

Sergeant Jung Moonho looked at me as if he was making a fuss. But you can't escape my eyes. In fact, he was barely injured.

I estimated what characteristics and skills he had through the information of Ways of Survival.

「[Strong Bone] and [Heavy Bone].」

After all, there was a reason this reader survived until now.

Obviously, his fighting ability itself is not outstanding, but one of the cool things is so outstanding that Lee Hyunsung is delighted.

As expected, I thought it was Jung Heewon's father, but suddenly the sentence of 'Ways of Survival' came to mind again.

「84th turn. Yoo Joonghyuk murmured as he watched the 'mad butcher' who did not collapse even after being hit by his sword.」

"You seem to have gotten bigger than the last time. Is it someone else?”

But he couldn't be sure. Strangely, his [sage's eye] did not work on that Mad Butcher.」

Sergeant Jung Moonho, feeling my gaze, asked.

"Why?"

"No, nothing."

After putting him on the bench, I went up to the stage, where the second contestant was already waiting.

"Are you second?"

"Is ark the second?"

The second contestant was the Ark.

He was, of course, an opponent I did not want to fight. Even with my eyes, I can see he is a stronger incarnation than me.

Even before the fight, the specs had improved, and the average overall ability had risen significantly.

I asked without showing any tension.

"How was the first match?"

From the moment the first match started, I couldn't take my eyes off the Ark's every move.

"You must have been disappointed. You probably didn't expect a performance like this."

To him, who was a master of Murim, all of this felt like child's play.

"It must be wrong to expect it."

But the Ark would not know.

That disappointment is also an intended emotion in this story.

"It can't be helped. The form of martial arts cannot be fully reproduced by a weak incarnation of the early stage of the scenarios."

"Of course it is."

"In that sense, why don't we change the way we fight the second match?"

"Change the way? How?"

"Since ancient times, there has been a fighting method that does not use internal energy at all. It is literally a fight to compete in the form of pure martial arts."

[The constellation 'Flying Dragon' is listening to your story.]

As if he hadn't expected me to make such a proposal, the Dragon Head Ark opened his eyes wide.

"You're quite an expert in martial arts. Did Kyrgios teach you?"

"I haven't heard it from Master, but I've heard that it's a fighting method that martial artists often prefer."

Of course it was bullshit.

If I had been the incarnation of a munchkin who drank the elixir from the beginning of the scenario, I would of course have chosen a melee battle using magical powers.

"How about it. If this is the way to fight, the weak incarnations of the early stage of the scenarios will be able to compete with the depth of the martial arts."

Even a comment that appropriately stimulates the nostalgia of the Dragon Head.

After thinking for a moment, the dragon-headed ark nodded.

"Okay. I accept the offer. I won't use my strength in this confrontation."

Watching the referee's hand slowly go up, I finished my preparations in my mind.

In fact, the reason I chose this fighting method was simple.

If it was a confrontation using my inner strength, I would lose quickly without even competing with the Dragon's Head Ark.

[Strength Lv.25 -> Strength Lv.40]

[Strength level greatly increases!]

[Agility Lv.25 -> AgilityLv.40]

[Agility level greatly increases!]

[Stamina Lv.25 -> Stamina Lv.40]

[Stamina level increases significantly!]

[Magic Power Lv.20 -> Magic Power Lv.40]

[Magic level increases significantly!]

[A total of 36,500 coins have been used.]

[A phenomenal coin usage achievement has been achieved!]

[15,000 coins will be refunded.]

However, the story is a little different if it is a confrontation that competes for 'pure physical ability'.

As if he knew my intentions, the dragon head ark held a sneer.

"Do you think you can beat me just because your overall stats went up a bit?"

"Yes. This alone will be difficult."

No matter how much I had the [White and Blue Steel], my skill level was only 1. However, if this wasn't a battle of inner strength through magical powers, I also had a good chance of winning.

If there is no barrier of mana management, it is because I can mimic the 'depth' of the person I want with a high degree of Probability.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.6' is activated to the limit!]

I slowly closed my eyes and thought of the person I wanted in my head.

And the next moment, my sense of awareness of my surroundings began to expand rapidly.

I recognized Seoul Station, Yongsangu with Seoul Station, the Korean Peninsula with Seoul, and the planet Earth with the Korean Peninsula.

I recognized the solar system, dreamed of the galaxy, and furthermore, an infinite universe without trillions of senses.

In a pale blue dot smaller than a speck of dust, I imagined the existence who imagines an infinite universe.

[The smallest is the greatest.]

As I slowly opened my eyes, the darkness of the universe lifted.

The dragon head ark was glaring at me with strange eyes.

"You bastard-"

Maybe he's seeing a vision of a familiar man in me right now.

「That day, a very short man appeared in front of the Beggar Sect.」

"Is this place the Beggar Sect?"

「The man opened his mouth in a low-pitched voice, as if he were appreciating his high education.」

"You look shabbier than I heard."

From now on, I am Kyrgios Rodgraim.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 636 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (5)

Of course, just because I [incited] myself to be Kyrgios didn't mean I could freely use the real Kyrgios's skills. [Incite] is different from [Bookmark].

However, [Incite] had a more outstanding part than [Bookmark].

「While 'Bookmark' borrows only one skill from the person in question, 'Incite' could really become the character itself depending on the use.」

As long as I can fool everyone who sees me.

[The Exclusive skill 'Incite' is affected by the attribute!]

I thought of 'Kyrgios Roadgrim'.

A small race born on the planet 'Peace Land'. The strongest of the <First Murim>, the Transcendental person who the stars fear.

The person who became too strong to save his hometown...

With a tingling feeling, the image of Kyrgios in my head became blurry.

The amount of text I had was absurdly insufficient to become 'Kyrgios Rodgraim' with this alone.

Fortunately, I had good materials to stretch my imagination.

[The Exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' is activated!]

[Skill synergy occurs!]

[The effect of 'Incite' is rapidly increasing!]

The sentences of 'Ways of Survival' began to flow into my head. Kyrgios's habits, hobbies, and things that he didn't even know were left as text. The expression he makes when he's angry. The gaze when looking at his disciples. The look in his eyes when he trains martial arts seriously. The smile he makes when he climbs high and plays the viola alone.

「Kyrgios Rodgraim.」

Everything written about Kyrgios was reproduced in my head, and the Kyrgios I understood was expressed again in my physical body.

「Kyrgios silently drew his sword.」

Unfortunately, what I did not have was his exclusive equipment, the Pure White Sword.

[Thoughts about almost everything mimicked the 'stick of Samyongdan'.]

But for now, this was enough.

「On the day when all the masters of the Murim were brought to their knees, the weapon Kyrgios was holding was a wooden sword for practice.」

The dragon head ark saw me, and I also saw the ark.

We lunged at each other almost simultaneously.

Kagagagak!

Two weapons colliding in the air.

Holding the old shotgun barrel, the Dragon Head Ark tilted its head and asked.

"You have a strange holy relic. Which star used to use the bamboo stick?"

"It is a Korean constellation called 'The Bald General of Justice'."

"It's a bit of a modifier, but the relic is excellent."

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' shrugs.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' wipes his head.]

"Now, show me Kyrgios's skills."

The baton of the ark moved.

Even though he didn't use his inner power at all, the batting stick wielded by the ark overflowed with sensible energy.

2nd baton method.

Dangdu Bongal.

The ark's exclusive unofficial baton method. Originally, the first batting stick, as the name suggests, was made to catch wild dogs.

「The beggars' nemesis was the dogs that fetched the discarded rice, and the beggars made a martial art to efficiently hit wild dogs to protect their rice bowls.」

Spot!

I twisted my body wide and avoided the batting stick falling on my head.

"It's quite good, but it's still clumsy."

The eyes of the ark wielding the batting stick were shining brightly. I was struck by those eyes with a wry smile that said that he would thoroughly tear down and evaluate each and every one of my movements.

The power of [Incite] spread throughout my body, and a clear sentence came to mind.

「Kyrgios's disciple starts training by sleeping on a bracelet at the same time as initiation, and learns introductory swordsmanship from the second year of wearing it correctly.」

In 'Omniscient Reader', Kyrgios's martial arts rarely appear. The only ones that appear are [Baekcheongganggi] and [Jeoninhwa]. It was because the others were meaningless to him, who had already risen to the ranks of the transcendental throne.

However, before transcending, Kyrgios also used numerous martial arts.

「Introductory Swordsmanship, White Blue Swordsmanship.」

I took a deep breath and sighed.

「Just pointing to a point in the universe.」

1st white-blue sword method.

One point.

At first glance, it was a simple stab. However, those who know the absurdity of this stabbing will never say that it is 'a simple stab'.

This is because Kyrgios's disciples repeat the same training for thousands of days for this one stab.

Only, to acquire a single sense.

「"It should literally feel like you're making a dot."」

Marking a single dot in the vast universe.

「"That way, the opponent will be able to appreciate the true value of this skill."」

My level 40 strength was condensed and I let out a scream.

One point is the beginning and end.

On top of that paradox, Kyrgios's question about the universe begins.

Little by little, a different color appeared in the eyes of the ark that greeted the point.

"It's clumsy, but it's definitely Kyrgios's swordsmanship."

As if the ark had waited, the shotgun barrel rotated. Even though he didn't use his inner energy, the shadow of the shotgun rose like a cloud.

Clouds of countless rising shadows buried a weak point of light.

Truly the pinnacle of the batting stick method.

But the stars didn't seem to think so.

[The constellation 'King Heungmu the Great' laughs.]

[The constellation 'The Two-Legged Expert' yawns at the boring confrontation.]

I know.

In the eyes of the constellations, our fight will be nothing more than a trivial clowning game.

For the super-strong who have mastered the subtleties of form, herbivory is nothing more than a standardized calculation method.

Nevertheless, the Dragon Head Ark was sincere.

He swung the batting stick with all his might, as if this insignificant fight was the life-and-death decision of a lifetime.

6 seconds of the baton method.

Foot structure.

A batting stick that ends up on the floor and is pushed up towards the sky.

I knew it the moment I saw this movement.

Whether it's a dog, a porcupine, or a groll, the representative of another station. Any creature hit by his baton would have died.

Then, as if performing a trick, the ark hit the fragments on the floor that floated in the air.

He hit it with a stick and sent it flying.

Sieeeeek!

Fragments of the broken floor shot at me like sharp arrows.

4th white-blue sword method.

Blue wheel.

Hold the sword positively. A technique that gently rotates a wheel to heat space.

Kyrgios’s defensive move to defend against flying arrows.

Several fragments that could not be fully blocked quickly grazed my forearms and thighs.

"That's funny. Kyrgios’s martial arts weren't like this at all."

However, contrary to what he said, a small smile was forming from the corner of the Ark's mouth.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' makes an interested expression.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' feels an unknown charm in your battle.]

The constellations in the sky were watching our fight.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' picks his nose, asking why they are so eager for such a trivial fight.]

[The constellation 'King of the Evil Stage' snorts.]

Of course, not everyone was in favor of this confrontation.

But there were definitely people watching this messy fight.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is cheering for your fight.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is watching you.]

I realize that there are many stars in this world all over again. Perhaps there is no story that can satisfy them all.

But in the first place, this story was not for them.

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier is watching your story.]

"Where do you take it!"

The bamboo stick and the dragon constantly collided. I was pushed back without even taking a deep breath at the series of consecutive attacks that flowed like water.

「"Walking is literally a way of walking. Keep in mind where you will and will not set foot. At one step that you think is nothing, someone dies and someone lives."」

In the midst of the sentences of 'Ways of Survival' that rushed in, I couldn't even tell if they were the words of Kyrgios or the words of the white and blue master who was

older than Kyrgios.

「"The important thing is to know the weight of your steps. The lightest can be the most mirrorless. That is the paradox of lightness spoken of in Baekcheong."」

Only I heard the steps and walked.

"It's really strange. It's unlikely that it's the footsteps of an educated person."

A sloppy, incoherent backward step. But even with that step, I evaded the baton of the ark.

I swung the bamboo stick as best as I could. It wasn't important to move well.

Just as every sentence contains context, the movements are just a vessel that holds meaning to Murin.

For example, it is like a finger pointing at the moon.

Ark said, narrowing his eyes.

"It is a skill that you cannot use today. You are-"

Most of my beginnings were full of failures. That should be the case at the current level of [ Incite] now.

There was no way it could be reproduced at the same level as Kyrgios.

The Kyrgios I read was perfect, but my physical abilities were infinitely poor.

But now, the gap has actually reduced.

"Why—"

Now the ark was watching. The one man on the other side that my stick pointed to.

"No. He was faster than that. It was heavier and more terrifying."

The ark, repeating his monologue, brandished a batting ball at me as if possessed.

Every time my bamboo stick collided with his baton, it seemed like there was a knocking sound from somewhere. The landscape of the world changed along the trajectory of the weapon that cut through the air.

「The man he wanted to fight for a long time was beyond that.」

The Ark swung his baton again and again like a man trying to follow that fantasy.

Despite the dizzying pain that pierced my shin and torso, I gritted my teeth and accepted his attacks.

I wanted to protect his fantasy.

The expression on the ark's face was filled with joy.

If someone had seen it, it would have been a terrible performance. There is no place to run away to, so there is no place to run, and there are times when I stumble and hit the floor with a weapon.

However, the scene of rain unfolding in the head of the ark right now is a bit different from that.

It would have been different.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' opens his mouth blankly.]

[Constellation 'Maritime War God' nods.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' doubts his own eyes.]

Some stories are only open to those who understand the context.

For some, sentences that are useless at all, for others, draw a desperate landscape.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks what the hell is everyone looking at.]

The utterly bewildered Ark murmured like a madman.

"Were you there, Kyrgios?"

「Then Kyrgios's dot split the sky.」

The fight that ends is an illusion built up with lies.

「The batting stick of the ark against him hit the ground.」

Even so, the moment the ark believed it. It became a reality.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' clenches his fist.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' exhales a sad breath.]

[The constellation 'Last Hero of the Yellow Mountain Bee' is immersed in the confrontation.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is breathing heavily.]

[The constellation 'King Heungmu the Great' reluctantly licks his lips.]

The warriors who once roamed the battlefield holding their weapons silently watched our fight.

They knew too.

This story is fake.

There is no Kyrgios here, the Beggar Sect is ruined, and Murim is no longer great.

「Murim in the Dragon's Head Ark has already disappeared from this world.」

Nonetheless, some stars who lived uninhabited for a time recalled their own landscapes that they remembered from our fight.

I could feel their emotions in the shimmering starlight.

They were envious.

They were truly envious of the Dragon Head Ark who was allowed to drop everything and go down to earth to experience this story himself.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' sponsors 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' sponsors 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'The Last Hero of the Yellow Mountain Bee' sponsors 100 coins.]

All those stars can do is support this fight.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' sponsors 100 coins and says that he seems to be seeing a bit.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' sees it, but he denounces what he can see.]

"Come! Kyrgios!"

The last herb of the ark unfolded, and I, too, squeezed all my strength as if I swung a sword.

The batting stick of the Ark broke with a loud sound. At the same time, my mimicry was also lifted.

We looked at each other with bated breath.

It was hard to breathe because I didn't use magic at all. [Incite] was released, and the recoil of my body pushed me away.

['Incite' is canceled.]

The Ark was staggering and watching me. His dreamy eyes returned.

As the scenery of Murim was cleared, the truth of the story was fully revealed. There was no Kyrgios who had suffocated him. I made him dream again.

Murim, his season is now gone forever.

"You…"

What remains here is a lonely star that has not forgotten the remorse of the past.

And it's just a shabby tale that can't even become a story.

"You're not a disciple of Kyrgios."

A sweet story written only for him. The star that woke up from that terrible dream was crying like a child.

"Why did you show me this scenery?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 637 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (6)

The ark's eyes were full of confusion. The reverberations of the scenery that enveloped him until the end still lingered.

Blinking slowly, a piece of the reverberation brushed the tip of his nose.

「When Murim was still alive, Kyrgios, the white and blue gatekeeper, and the dragon-headed ark met.」

The Ark was defeated, and he desperately vowed revenge, but in the end he never met Kyrgios again.

What he wanted was to fight Kyrgios once again in Murim.

However, Kyrgios achieved transcendence and went beyond the distant sky, and he chose the path of a constellation, abandoning most of his human emotions.

That's why I made this story.

To release the long-cherished wish of a star that could not be fulfilled.

Where the ark wants, in the form the ark wants. To meet Kyrgios and have him fight once again.

The ark, who had come all the way, aimed a broken batting ball at me.

"Tell me, why did you show me this scenery?"

If he hits with the baton now, I won't be able to avoid it.

Outside of the stage, Jung Heewon was seen putting her hand on the hilt of her sword.

I tried to dissuade her with the look in my eyes and then told the ark.

"You already know, don't you?"

"I know?"

The ark stared blankly at me.

"There was a story, and now it's over. That's all I have to say."

His baton was pointed at me and trembled faintly.

[The constellation 'Last Hero of the Yellow Mountain Bee' is silent. ]

[The constellation 'King Heungmu the Great' sighs.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' wipes his head quietly.]

His lips opened slowly.

"I am..."

[The constellation 'Goryeo’s First Sword' asks The Last Ruler to show the dignity of the stars.]

The ark suddenly raised his head at the indirect message that came from the air.

There was deep resentment in his eyes as he gazed up at the sky.

"Personality? Is it quality?"

A mournful voice.

Looking at that ark, I thought about the reason why he decided to come down to this earth.

「What is the reason why the last ark came into the scenarios?」

Did he come down only to resurrect the Beggar Sect?

Maybe.

This naive star might have believed that he could become stronger if he really started from the beginning of the scenarios.

So, it may be that he participated in this ordeal in order to develop his strength to once again challenge Kyrgios and the Slashing Swordsman in the sky.

「"The paradox of white-blue and the Pacheon Swordsman. I will meet them again someday, and I will surely be acknowledged."」

But there was a contradiction in his story.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' says it's okay to be honest.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' shakes her head slowly.]

Why did he bother to start all over again?

If the purpose was simply to meet Kyrgios or the celestial swordsman and seek revenge, it would have been possible while maintaining the status of a constellation.

"What do you know about talking like that? I am different from you. I mean, I'm right here. Unlike you who watch from across the sky—"

The gaze of the ark, who had been looking around wildly, stopped. Following his gaze, I saw a spotted boy near the stage.

「The possessed body of the 'ark' right in front of me is the father of the spotted boy.」

[The constellation 'King Heungmu the Great' says that if you really wanted to be proud, starting with 'Possessed Body' is a mistake.]

[Very few constellations point out the contradiction of the ark.]

This time, the stars were right.

If the ark was really proud, he should have been reincarnated as an ordinary incarnation.

In other words, he didn't really risk his all.

The sparks bouncing out of the air right now were proof of that.

Tchutsutsutsu.

He came down to the ground for a while, but he was still a spectator of this story, just a momentary happening, and he was just a spectator on the stage.

The spectator opened his mouth to the other members of the audience.

"Yes, you guys are right."

A light thunderclap could be heard from across the distant sky, and rain poured through a hole in the ceiling of Seoul Station.

As the entire curtain began to get wet, the outline of a huge stone covered with a cloth was revealed on the side of the stage.

I immediately recognized the stone.

「A meteorite.」

Perhaps that meteorite was the culprit that made a hole in the ceiling of Seoul Station.

The Ark looked at the meteorite for a moment.

That meteorite that suddenly fell from the sky, as if it were him.

The rain-soaked head of the ark slowly fell to the floor.

"I just ran away."

One thing he knows, I know, and the constellations know is that he didn't come here for an honorable cause, nor did he come here for the solemn carpenter.

He was just running away from the context of the constellations.

Despairing at the height of the sky he had to climb, he was just a star that had fallen to the ground.

Even in the midst of that, leaving behind a rope to return to the sky.

"I... just."

"You must have just wanted to see the story. Just like other constellations do."

The ark lifted his head and saw me.

"Just a little closer."

You could call him cowardly.

You could say it was pathetic, it was lousy, it was just an escape from reality.

But everyone dreams of vicarious satisfaction and catharsis.

Just as Kim Dokja reads 'Ways of Survival' featuring Yoo Joonghyuk, the constellations watch the stories of the Star Stream.

Just as Uriel and other constellations had no choice but to watch the story of Kim Dokja.

A being reads a story and becomes someone other than itself several times.

Because without that, you can't live in this crazy world.

"Do you see this story well now?"

There are those who want to run away but do not have the courage to run away.

The reason why the constellations envied him was probably because at least the ark had the courage to run away.

As if dizzy, the ark put his hand on his head and asked me.

"Who the hell are you? What do you want, why do you do this to me..."

"What I want is."

What I want has already been said.

A summons level elixir and the purple flag he possesses.

But that's probably not the answer he's looking for right now.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice is waiting for your answer.]

[Very few constellations listen to you.]

The constellations were watching over me.

Everyone is waiting for the point of this story.

I opened my mouth.

"A discussion."

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' groans.]

Ark's eyes slowly widened.

"I am a member of the political faction, and I want an agreement of the Beggar Sect, which was an old faction."

Righteousness.

It is the old banner of Murim, and a word that no one speaks anymore.

The ark's lips twisted slightly.

Was it funny that I said such a thing when I was wet in the rain? Or was it that he was miserable when he heard those words?

However, the voice that came out of his mouth after that, as if it was okay now, was released.

"You're a disciple of Kyrgios."

Very slowly, I felt something tickling in my heart.

It was a feeling I felt after a long time.

「No one here died, and we came all this way.」

Was this how I felt when you stayed up all night writing a chapter and finally got the end right in front of me?

The Ark sighed lightly and opened his mouth.

"You said you wanted an elixir."

The beggars around us could be seen cheering at the sudden declaration of the ark. The owner of the ark restrained such beggars with his hand and continued.

"And the flag."

I nodded.

"Don’t you think that greed is excessive?"

"It's because I can't go on without being greedy."

"Arrogant guy. Keep it in mind, you've been overly lucky today."

As he muttered that, he moved to the edge of the stage and approached me holding the purple flag erected there.

"Are you confident? Receiving this flag means that you have to take responsibility for the 'Beggar Sect' I created. There are three hundred beggars following me here."

I followed the gaze of the ark and slowly looked around. The beggars surrounding the stage were watching us, their eyes filled with fear and horror.

Three hundred.

It was more than all the incarnations in Chungmuro Station put together.

"Are you ready to accept them as your family?"

Honestly, I wasn't sure.

I am a person who has never been a class leader even when I was young, but in order to become a 'king', I have to eventually have a group and grow my power.

I know. This will eventually become my homework.

"All I can do is try my best to get you out of here."

The Ark cast a fierce glance at me.

"That's not enough."

"I'm the disciple of the Kyrgios. Don't expect more than that."

"How long will you be-"

The Ark, who was still glaring at me, added with a light sigh.

"If you aren’t really Kyrgios' disciple, you will be killed by him a hundred times more."

I guess so.

It may already be over at the point of impersonating Kyrgios’s disciple.

Anyway, there's something I want to make clear about this.

"By the way, when you say I accept the Beggar Sect as family members, does it include you?"

In fact, it would be all the better for now if he would just come under my command.

No matter how great a Constellation is, he is a 'constellation', so I somehow managed to throw it away because it was a fight that didn't use my inner power, but if it was a real confrontation, I wouldn't have lasted more than thirty seconds.

「But is that an ending suitable for the end of this turn?」

I know I shouldn't say this. Still, I couldn't help but open my mouth.

"I want you to go back to your original place. You still have a place in the sky. You came here not as an incarnation, but as a possession."

After all, all stories exist to return readers to their original world.

"I am—"

Just as he read my story, I also read his story.

Only those who have lived splendid stories like Kyrgios, Pacheon Swordsman, or Yoo Joonghyuk can talk about 'the best life'.

Even if he lived this way and that way and lived a pitiful story, the ark in front of me was also a star in the sky.

"You finally got there through your efforts. Even if you lose the Beggar Sect, lose Murim, and even lose your vengeance, the story you built up to get there doesn't become meaningless."

"You arrogant incarnation bastard. How dare you teach a constellation?"

Did I cross the line too much?

But the ark didn't look very angry. He looked at me once, then looked up at the sky again.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' nods.]

Then he said in a weary voice.

"Take the flag. And, the elixir-"

It was then that sparks flew out of the air. At first, I thought it was just an effect of excessive use of the probability of the possessed body.

"The medicine."

The ark's expression was strange.

Instinctively, I jumped up from where I was standing.

"The original price is wrong."

Amidst the sound of rain hitting my ears, I heard the sound of something ominous opening its mouth. When I raised my head reflexively, I saw a blackish-swaying portal above the sky over Seoul Station.

The Great Hall!

However, the fifth scenario had not yet started, and only monsters of a lower species could cross over that 'hole', so—

「Wrong. There was one more thing that could come over.」

I reflexively looked at the meteorite that fell in the center of Seoul Station.

An ominous feeling flickered in my mind.

「Where did 'The Last Ark' borrow the probability of the possessed body?」

If that meteorite.

「What constellation dares to lend probability to him?」

If it flew from the 'other world'.

Tsutsutsutsutsutsutsu!

The dark red magic that flowed from the meteorite wrapped around the dragon head ark and the dead.

The ark floating in the air was talking to me.

"Don't interrupt the story."

A voice that gives goosebumps just by hearing it. It was not the ark that dwelled in it. The eyes of the eroded dragon head ark were dyed black.

"You foolish world recorder."

It wasn't a mantra. Even so, hearing that voice made my stomach rumble and turn over.

I now realize who is saying it.

'An Outer God.'

When you think about it, it was natural.

No matter how much he put down his rank, what 'constellation' could possess an incarnation in the early scenarios?

Of course, I was expecting something like this to happen.

When I looked back, Jung Heewon was running toward me. I could see Sergeant Jung Moonho behind her, and her younger brother Jung Eunho on her back.

「How was this story originally destined to end?」

It seemed like a pitch black story was flowing from the whole body of the ark, but it soon covered the entire stage.

"That kind of story."

The black-stained floor boiled over as if to swallow me.

"We don't go along."

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' warns you of danger!]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' is screaming!]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice'...]

…

[The constellation 'The Last Ruler' apologizes to you.]

I ignored the messages from the constellations and ran forward.

Dangerous or not, the only chance was now.

If I was really destined to die, the snow field would have already been activated.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.6' is activated!]

When [Incite] was activated twice in a row, the muscles of my whole body seemed to be torn apart.

My eyes were bloodshot, and a stinging pain arose in my heart.

But I didn’t stop.

['Thoughts of almost everything' mimicks 'Broken Faith (mass production type)'!]

'Thought' was changed to 'Broken Faith'.

[Exclusive Skill 'White Blue Steel Lv.1' is activated!]

I activated the special option of [Broken Faith] learned from LiteraryGirl64.

[The Blade of Faith activates!]

The strongest anti-personnel weapon that I can use now.

「Now, the power to control the body is flowing from that meteorite.」

In other words, if only the meteorite is removed, the ark will no longer be able to use his power.

"No use."

The new model of the dragon head ark blocked the front as if he had been waiting for it.

I swung my sword without hesitation.

Kuddudd!

The blow of my conversion was blocked in vain by the sword wielded by the Dragon's Head Ark.

I expected it.

No matter how strong the combo of [White and Blue Steel] and 'Broken Faith' was, the enemy now was a crazy monster mixed with the spirit of the constellation and the divine protection of the other world.

Tsutsutsuchu!

At least while he was able to throw away that probability, even if Yoo Joonghyuk came, it would be difficult for him to deal with him, let alone me.

But I laughed.

"It's no use."

Because I have already achieved my goal.

[You have obtained the 'Seoul Station Group' flag.]

My purpose from the beginning was not to remove the meteorite.

[Your 'white flag absorbs the cumulative achievement value of the 'purple flag'.]

[Your 'white flag' evolves into a 'purple flag'.]

It was to pick up a flag that had fallen on the floor.

「With the effect of the purple flag, we have gained control over the Seoul Station group.」

I've always been curious.

Is the 'god of another world' existing outside the scenario strong, or is the probability of the system constituting the scenario in this world stronger?

I could see the eyes of the dragon head Ark staring at me slowly widening.

I smiled at the guy and opened my mouth.

"Kneel down, you motherfucker."

['Punishment' is used.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 638 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (7)

Punishment.

An authority that a station leader can use to control his or her group members.

['Discipline' is affected by the flag level.]

[Currently, your flag rank is 'Purple'.]

The higher the grade of the flag, the higher the power of the authority.

Perhaps the ark gave to me in advance knowing how things would turn out.

Maybe.

For me now, 'the system' is the only weapon against them.

Tsutsutsutsuchu!

At the same time as the punishment was activated, pure white lightning flashed across the entire body of the ark in front of me.

"That, that, that...?"

The dragon-headed ark with his eyes wide open trembled as if in pain. A rustling sound came from his half-open lips.

"Buy! Girl!"

At the same time, standing by his side, four beggars each pulled out their batting balls.

But I was neither surprised nor embarrassed.

"You seem to be misunderstanding something."

[Use 'discipline'.]

"They are now my 'family' too."

Electricity raged, and the envoys who rushed towards me knelt on the floor. As if the pain was severe, some of them even missed the mallet and were complaining of pain.

"Ugh, ah, ah, ah."

I wonder if it's still bearable, the ark still glaring at me was not on his knees.

I breathed in lightly and used 'punishment' once again.

[Increase the level of 'punishment'!]

The purple flag sucked my mana, and an even more powerful electric shock burned the whole body of the ark.

Eventually, the knees of the ark bent down.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' admires your base!]

It was natural.

Unfortunately, this world was not a favorable place for an Outer God.

They were the beings who were abandoned in the 'scenario', and this was the world of the scenario.

A world with fixed stories, roles, and main characters. Like minor actors who are no longer used, this world doesn't want a 'god from another world'

[The constellation 'King Heungmu the Great' orders a stronger punishment.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' shouts, saying that miscellaneous things from the other world are being installed.]

[The constellation 'Flying Dragon' says he needs to taste some bitterness.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' licks his lips.]

I smiled bitterly at their reaction.

Indeed, when a truly terrifying deity from the other world descended from the 'Dark Castle' or the 'Pandemonium', none of them helped Kim Dokja.

That meant that the Outer God in front of me right now was not a high-level Outer God like 'The Nameless Mist'.

When one of the old beings, 'Eater of Dreams', descended in 'Omniscient Reader', the entire Dark Castle was almost destroyed. However, this guy didn't have the momentum to overwhelm the whole area.

Probably a sub-species equivalent to 'nameless things', among them, those with a rank similar to or lower than that of the constellation.

I spoke to the deity dwelling in the ark.

"What are you? Why are you here?"

Ordinarily, it was impossible to even talk to an 'Outer God'.

Because the moment they hear their voices, ordinary mortals lose their reason in madness and fear.

But the guy in front of me was different.

Perhaps because it coexists with the soul of a constellation in a human body, it was possible to speak and listen to it through human voice.

The next moment the guy opened his mouth.

"We are."

Vomit poured out of the mouth of the ark with the sound in Seoul Station. Black blood vessels stood out all over his body.

I rushed to ask.

"You saw me earlier and called me the world's recorder. What does that mean?"

The man raised his head again and said each word clearly.

"Recorder."

Now, the guy with blood vessels sticking out to his lips vomited out his words as if it were difficult.

"Recorder of Fear."

In an instant, goosebumps appeared on my forearms.

Recorder of Fear.

Certainly, there were beings with such a title in 'Omniscient Reader'.

「Recorder of Fear. The first humans to meet the Outer Gods, and the writers who spread their existence.」

However, there was no description of who they were or what kind of existence they were.

"You smell like them."

"Tell me more. What kind of people are the 'recorders of fear'?"

But instead of answering, he just stared blankly at me.

Somewhere, I heard the sound of a small bird chirping.

「Savemesavemesaveme」

「Weareinnocentweareinnocentweareinnocent」

「Don'tforgetdon'tforgetdon'tforget」

The distant universe, the sound from beyond the 'Great Hall'.

The ark opened his mouth again with eyes looking for sympathy.

"Recorder of Fear."

「Writeitdownwriteitdownwriteitdownwriteitdown」

"Forgive me."

I was immediately taken aback by the tone that seemed to be praying for a mistake. Perhaps it was because of the screams of the stories that resonated in my head, but my heart weakened for a moment and I lowered the level of 'punishment'.

"Ark. Calm down. Are you intending to have your possessed body stolen by the Outer God?"

If the punishment continued to intensify like this, it seemed that the ark's possessed body would not be able to withstand it. Then the spotted boy would lose his father.

The Ark seemed to have heard me, but his eyes returned in an instant.

"Punishment."

But the ark couldn't speak any further. I don't know if he meant to make the punishment stronger or weaker. The eyes of the ark were completely black, and both hands of the ark on his knees touched the floor.

The moment when a bleak sensation rose up my spine.

I looked back and cried.

"Everybody cover your ears!"

MurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurim
MurimMulimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurimMurim」

At the same time, nearby beggars collapsed with blood flowing from their ears.

I too stumbled and knelt down.

[Exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' is strongly activated!]

If it wasn't for the 'Ways of Survival' that was activated just in time, I would have become a chisel like them.

「Yoo Joonghyuk knew. There is only one way to get out of the spiritual soak when you meet an 'Outer God'.」

「Only believe in the story you have.」

I didn't have a story.

「Yoo Joonghyuk thought.」

However, there was the story of 'Ways of Survival'.

「'I am a regressor, my time is infinite. I will become infinitely stronger, so the day will surely come when I become stronger than I am. The definite future is soon a fact. Therefore, I am already stronger than the Outer God.'」

It was painful to listen to Yoo Joonghyuk's bizarre logic, but I was able to stay sane anyway thanks to 'Ways of Survival'.

Fortunately, the mantra of the 'Outer God' did not continue.

Instead, the darkness covering the ground around the area began to radiate strange energy.

[A world view check occurs.]

A worldview invasion?

[Anomalies from another world rise in the dark.]

Strange creatures crawled out of the unarmored floor.

In an instant, my heart skipped a beat.

「If a monster like the 'Nameless One' pops up here, we will die.」

Fortunately, what came out of the darkness was not the 'Nameless One'.

It is the main scenario after the 90th scenario where the 'Nameless One' is on the ground.

Right now, the Earth is only in the fourth scenario.

Then what are those?

The smell of old books flowing around the unarmed ground, and the smell of grass and soil that can only be rolled in deep mountains.

There was something that jumped out at me.

After the fourth scenario, 'Capture the Flag', the 'Fifth Scenario' begins.

Once opened, the invasion from Kronos's world begins.

However, those monsters were not the creatures of 'Kronos' no matter how you look at them.

[The 8th grade alien species, the Jiangshi, stand up in the dark.]

Beggars screamed and whipped batons against them. Jung Heewon, Sergeant Jung Moonho, and Sergeant Kim also shouted while protecting their colleagues.

Even with my width, I could see several Jiangshi turning around.

It was difficult to understand the situation.

I know the worldview invasion has begun.

But why did it suddenly appear here?

The 7th level extraterrestrial wind, 'Reduce City', reveals its hostility towards you!

As I dodged the attacks, I recalled the contents of the 'invasion of the world view' in my head.

「The fifth scenario is a confrontation between worlds. Humanity fighting against the attacking other world. Just as Seoul is being eroded by Kronos, China will be eroded by the 3rd Murim World, and Japan will be eroded by the White Yo World.」

The 3rd Murim Realm.

Only then did it feel like everything was connected as one.

Of course, the dragon head ark from Murim appeared here. Everything made sense, even the sudden appearance of a group called 'Beggar Sect' in Korea.

「'The 3rd Murim World' is a world view where the development of the Dragon's Head Ark ran away with the Beggar Sect.」

In other words, that meteorite from another world that can be seen right in front of me is...

「Originally, a meteorite that should have fallen in China.」

Did it all start with this meteorite?

A sigh came out inside.

I don't know which dokkaebi didn't do things right, but-

—Hey, are you alive?

An inconsistent voice. The dokkaebi, gasping for breath in the air, continued.

—Damn it, a low-class dokkaebi set the meteorite's fall point incorrectly... can you handle that?

I know very well how the public situation is going.

'No problem.'

-Really?

I nodded.

We've come this far, but if the administration suddenly intervened and took away the reward, that would be a bigger problem.

'Please prepare the reward right away.'

Rather, it is an opportunity.

It happened that the ark didn't give me the summoning class elixir, so if I deal with that godhead, I might be able to receive a reward equivalent to that from the administration.

If only there was one problem.

"Go go go go go go go..."

In order to prevent this situation, the ark had to be killed.

[The 7th grade alien species 'jiangshi' is roaring at you!]

My forehead was cut by the long fingernails of the jiangshi.

Unfortunately, with my current abilities, I can't take down many of the 7th class.

But they were Jiangshi, and I had a holy relic.

I called up the bamboo pole with 'thought', and immediately injected magic power into it.

['Bamboo pole' demonstrates powerful anti-demon powers!]

This bamboo jang is a holy relic with the strongest anti-demon function on the Korean Peninsula.

In other words, it was a perfect match for Jiangshi, a type of devil.

[The 7th grade alien species, 'jiangshi' feels fear and backs down.]

I ran past the Jiangshi without missing the timing.

[Activate 'Discipline' at full output!]

Aaaaaaa!

The authority of the system began attacking the Outer God. The area of invasion of the worldview that had been spreading blackly shrank in an instant.

"Die, Ark!"

I swung the bamboo stick straight at the guy.

Of course, I didn't really mean to kill him.

If this vessel dies, the spotted boy's father will die too.

What matters is the gesture.

A gesture that at least I will definitely end this situation.

[The incarnation 'Myung Sewoon"s being dwells all at once canceling the possession!]

Also.

Right before the bamboo shard touched it, the 'Outer God' turned into a whitish spiritual body and came out of the body. In an instant, it circled the ceiling of Seoul Station, and soon found a new object of possession and rushed at it.

「IwantyouIwantyouIwantyouIwantyou」

I knew exactly where he was going.

「Writeitdownwriteitdownwriteitdownwriteitdown」

That was me.

Tsutsutsutsutsutsu!

When the aura of divine power that flew in an instant struck me directly at the top of my head, the world went completely dark.

It was a feeling I had never experienced before, but I knew a sentence to accurately describe it.

「It's like when Kim Dokja was swallowed by the 'dream eater' in the 'Dark Castle'.」

When I fully opened my eyes, I was in my spirit body.

What I see around me is a pure white field of snow.

【Stupid recorder】

Here is my 'inner world'.

【Cross-clap-clap】

I turned my head to the place where I heard the strange laughter. I saw a guy who had infiltrated my world.

The shape of a cephalopod about ten meters long. That seemed to be his body.

It's smaller than the 'Dream Eater' that Kim Dokja dealt with, but at least he didn't seem to be an ordinary guy as he signed a contract with a constellation.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' asks what happened.]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' says that it seems that a monster from the other world entered the body of that incarnation.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' sponsors you with 100 coins and asks if you're okay.]

I heard a message from the stars who couldn't look inside me.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' worries about your safety.]

[The constellation 'The Prisoner of the Golden Headband' asks the Administration Bureau to send out the screen.]

It's a shame that I can't show the scenery here to those stars, but maybe one of them can see this scenery.

"Ark."

[The constellation 'The Last Ruler' watches your battle.]

It seemed so.

Since the development of the Dragon's Head Ark has been contracted with that 'Outer God', he will probably be able to watch this story.

"From now on, I will show you the story you want."

This is a story for only one spectator.

[The skill 'Incite Lv.6' is activated!]

In the reality outside, I disguised as Kyrgios with [Incite]. However, I lacked magic power and lacked proficiency in martial arts, so what the Ark and the constellations actually saw were just weak illusions based on their memories.

But here it is different.

[Scalar's penalty in that area is temporarily lifted!]

Here, neither physical fatigue nor probability affects us.

[Enter the snow field.]

[Describe your actions.]

[5 probability points are exhausted.]

This space is pure white paper. The only power to rule this space is imagination.

「Writer Lee Hakhyun started writing a sentence.」

Just like when I fought with Han Sooyoung.

[The constellation 'Last Ark' sighs and breathes.]

The magic of the [White and Blue Steel] that fills my whole body. As I slowly blinked, I could feel the energy of Kyrgios that brightly colored the surroundings.

My magic-powered hair was dyed azure and swayed in the wind.

「Kyrgios Rodgrim was there.」

Perhaps realizing that something was wrong, the Outer God panicked and backed away from the floor, then started running away.

【Kak Kak Kak Kak Kak Kak Kak Kak】

White-blue, the word that perfectly suited Kyrgios blossomed into a tale in my hands.

Kyrgios's exclusive weapon.

「Pure White Paradox.」

When I laughed, Kyrgios laughed.

「"Get out of here, monster from the other world."」

A speed with no time to follow with the eye.

The wave of lightning that erupted from the tip of the blade burned the fleeing Outer God and cut it in two.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 639 Episode 16 Mad Butcher (8)

The deity of the other world who was struck by lightning groaned as it poured out fragments of stories.

Fragments of stories that had lost their context were split into words and then disappeared into consonants or vowels.

[Constellation 'The Last Ark' has achieved its longing.]

[Constellation 'The Last Ark' is released from the contract with the Outer God.]

As expected, the ark was bound by a contract with the Outer God.

[The constellation 'The Last Ark' expresses his gratitude to you.]

[The constellation 'The Last Ark' tells you his story.]

I was surprised.

No matter how much I did, you're already giving away your own story?

However, there was no time to check what story I had received.

【Go each go ah no kid】

The 'Outer God' that had not yet disappeared dragged its upper body and howled.

【Gear▪You are g▪▪… will be angry】

Anyway, it has to end.

I am ready to activate [All-In-One] once again.

【You are not a recorder.】

He looked back at me with his cunning eyes.

Hwa-ah-ah, and the whole story of that guy was scattered like sand blowing in the wind. I couldn't feel his energy.

I had an ominous feeling.

Where did he go?

Just in time, the space spun once, and I was also forcibly thrown out of the snowfield.

I came out.

As soon as my blackened vision returned, what I saw was an old unarmed floor. The scent of blood hung on the tip of my nose.

I staggered and looked around.

How are the others?

My hearing returned, and I heard the voices of people buzzing everywhere. The sound of sharp bouncing weapons brought me to full reality.

The fight was still going on.

"Everyone stand back!"

Fortunately, the other world’s invasion seemed to have stopped.

Dozens of Jiangshi left.

It was also a sign that it was being organized smoothly under the leadership of Jung Heewon.

Where did that guy go?

He must have escaped here, but there was no trace of the Outer God anywhere.

My eyes met Jung Heewon’s, who was watching this from afar. As I was about to open my mouth, Jung Heewon opened her eyes wide and cried out.

"Avoid!"

When I turned around with a chilly feeling, something attacked from behind.

Among the 7th grade, it was jiangshi.

Damn, was there still one left?

However, the condition of the monster was a bit strange.

[A 7th grade alien species, 'jiangshi' attempts : Explosion of blood points.]

Blood points. The dark red aura that wrapped around his whole body was expanding as if it would explode. I can understand what kind of technology it is without having to explain it.

I lightly moved my feet and tried to run away from him. However.

[Physical ability has been drastically reduced due to the penalty of 'incite'.]

The recoil of the [Incite] I used earlier has finally returned. My feet didn't move on my own. For an instant, a cold sweat broke out on my back.

"Get out of the way!"

Fortunately, Jung Heewon was faster. At this rate, Jung Heewon will save me before jiangshi explodes.

However, the price was strange. A chilly feeling, as if I left out an important sentence on the page I just wrote.

Behind Jung Heewon's back, squeezing between the ranks of Jiangshi, another jiangshi was running.

[The 7th grade alien species, 'jiangshi' attempts a 'Blood Point Explosion'!]

Damn.

There was one more.

And where the Jiangshi was headed.

「You aren’t a recorder」

The last words left by the Outer God rang in my ears.

I cried reflexively.

"Heewon-ssi! Block it from behind!"

Realizing something, Jung Heewon looked where my gaze was heading.

[The activation conditions for the exclusive skill '□□' have been met.]

[Entering the snow field.]

The world quickly turned achromatic. Fortunately, the skill was activated in time.

[Exclusive skill '□□' has been activated.]

[A branch of an important event has occurred.]

I quickly looked around in the still landscape.

Skill '□□' is activated only when a character wants to do an 'unexpected action' or when an 'important event' divergence occurs.

This time, it was said to be a branch of 'important events'.

In other words, it means that an event that will become a turning point in the development of this world will begin right here and now.

#Mad Butcher

「At that moment, Jung Heewon □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□…」

*You can add up to 300 characters based on your current proficiency level.

[You can stay in the 'Snowfield' for a total of 8 minutes.]

I blankly stared at the title of the scene.

'Mad Butcher'.

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st turn said.

If I want to be his ally, recruit the 'Mad Butcher' as an ally.

It wasn't difficult at this point.

Soon, I will be able to gain Yoo Joonghyuk's trust and plan my survival in this turn. That's it.

Certainly, when I first possessed a character in this world, I was a person who just needed that.

「But now, Lee Hakhyun didn't know if that was the right thing to do.」

I was out of breath. Space and time stopped, and even though my body was stiff, my heart was beating without rest.

「Lee Hakhyun didn't want to bring 'Mad Butcher' to Yoo Joonghyuk.」

There are stories I don't want to write about as a writer. I also have the freedom not to write a story I don't want to write.

Because now I knew who the 'Mad Butcher' was.

However, when I realized that the ending of a dazzling turn was right in front of me, and that the story would be completed with just one more sentence, how many writers could reject the last sentence?

[The protagonist of this stage was Jung Heewon.]

Jung Heewon, who was running toward me, was looking back.

I was in front of her, and her younger brother Jung Eunho was behind her.

It was fine until there.

The problem was that two Jiangshi in both directions were each targeting us.

They were running towards me in one way, and running towards Jung Eunho on the other.

Both Jiangshis are preparing for a self-destruct attack.

Those she doesn't save will die with a high probability.

After calming down, I organized the sentences in my head.

The title of this scene is 'Mad Butcher'.

However, it was not written who it was or what it was about. It is me who writes it down. It is also me who completes this story.

I started writing sentences.

Sincerely, with dense sentences. With the best expressions I can write.

「So, Jung Heewon miraculously saved both of them. (Total 297 characters)」

Even though I wrote that.

[This is absolutely impossible.]

[The success rate of reproducing this description is less than 0.01%.]

[You lack the probability allowed.]

[Read reader feedback.]

0.01%.

> rlaehrwk37: …
>
> rlaehrwk78: Honestly this is far-fetched

I knew that too.

It was physically impossible for the current Jung Heewon to save both me and her brother.

Still, until now, how many times have I made a similar argument?

On the bridge where I met Yoo Joonghyuk, just as I sacrificed my arms to save the others.

I wrote the sentence over and over again.

If this is not possible, I can give up a few things. Her younger brother is somehow saved, and I am severely injured, but I have to write it in the form of surviving.

[The success rate of reproducing this description is less than 0.01%.]

[You lack the probability allowed.]

…

[The success rate of reproducing this description is less than 0.01%.]

[You lack the probability allowed.]

…

It was strange.

No matter how it was used, the success rate of reproduction was absurdly low.

…

[Check reader feedback]

> rlaehrwk99: Are important people unconditionally saved?
>
> rlaehrwk141: Then that's a bit obvious

A storm rose in my head.

I knew it was a story lacking in probability. However, the reaction of readers was shocking.

> rlaehrwk41: Didn't Omniscient Reader explode people's heads from the beginning?
>
> rlaehrwk37: Be quiet newbie
>
> rlaehrwk124: Bittersweet but that's what makes it fun

In the feedback from the following readers, it was seen that the time of the timer was decreasing.

[The time limit is 2 minutes.]

I saw Jung Heewon, and I saw Jung Eunho. I don't have time anymore. There were not many sentences to write.

In a world where everything I write becomes reality, what sentence should a writer write?

What sentences can he write?

What does it mean to write a good work as a writer?

I still don't know the answer.

[You lack the probability allowed.]

Allowed probability.

Fortunately, I had the probability points I had accumulated so far.

Can 'probability points' make the impossible possible? As with Jung Heewon’s awakening, if I use the collected probability once again—

[Currently, 'probability input' is impossible due to a skill error.]

Skill error.

Come to think of it, since the last fight with Han Sooyoung, the skill [□□] has gone sour.

[You have 1 minute left on the time limit.]

My head started going blank.

If this continues, either I or Jung Eunho will surely die.

「At that time, someone came into Lee Hakhyun’s field of view.」

I blankly opened my mouth.

Perhaps.

「There was only one way that Jung Eunho and I can both live.」

I looked at one person.

It was like lightning flashed in my head. Even though I knew I shouldn't use it like that, I couldn't stop my hand. As if my hand existed to complete that sentence.

And.

「… It was the end of the story that the reader wanted. (Total 297 characters)」

[The success rate of reproducing the description is over 90%.]

[You have described plausible content.]

Surprisingly high reproduction success rate.

The skill was talking, and readers were talking.

> rlaehrwk37: This is how it ends
>
> rlaehrwk99: (tears)
>
> rlaehrwk41 : Sniff

My writing hand trembled

Readers were right. If Jung Eunho and I were to survive at the same time, this was the only way.

But this was a story that shouldn't be written.

No matter how perfect a story is, there are definitely stories that shouldn't be written.

That was the story for me now.

I erased all the sentences I had written and started writing again.

「Lee Hakhyun has made up his mind.」

Even if the reproduction success rate is 0.01%

[The time limit is 30 seconds.]

[This description is absolutely impossible.]

[The success rate of reproducing this description is less than 0.01%.]

This time, impossible.

Let's write a good story.

[There are 20 seconds left.]

[This is absolutely impossible.]

[The success rate of reproducing this description is less than 0.01%]

Never give up, over and over again.

Again and again.

[The time limit is 10 seconds.]

[This is absolutely impossible.]

[The success rate of reproducing this description is less than 0.01%.]

…

Why can't I just write this story?

[Exiting from 'Snowfield'.]

The colors of the world were returning. In the midst of that soaring landscape, I thought maybe I was not qualified as a writer.

I wrote what I wanted to write, not sentences to complete the work.

The success rate was slim, and the reproduction success rate was close to zero.

Still, I prayed.

If anyone is reading this story, please add some Probability to it.

[Failed to reproduce the scene.]

The first message I heard.

A feeling of desolation flooded into my lungs.

The sentences I wrote were not reproduced. They did not become a reality.

However.

「Does the failed sentence remain in the story?」

The moment I heard the sentence that followed, goosebumps ran through my body.

Because I knew that sentence.

「Lee Hakhyun screamed.」

That sentence is a sentence I wrote and then erased.

"No! Go back! Hurry up!"

「In an instant, Jung Heewon made a choice.」

But actually, it was a story that I didn't even want to write.

"Inho-ssi!"

「'Saving Cheon Inho.'」

Jung Heewon, holding me, kicked at jiangshi, who rushed towards me.

The moment this sound floated in the air, Jung Heewon activated [Ghost Killing] and [Time of Judgment].

She threw the knife with Kwon Nong's sword directly into the monster at the time of reduction.

With the overwhelming cutting power of the blade, jiangshi could not attack and was cut in two on the spot.

The problem was the opposite.

"Jung Eunho!"

I saw the jiangshi running toward Jung Eunho, who had collapsed on the floor.

I could feel the disquieting legend of 'Outer God' in the whole body of the monster. At the last moment, the jiangshi was smiling at me.

「Why are they doing this?」

I actually know the answer.

「They want to be recorded in this story.」

It felt like everything in the world was flowing slowly, in slow motion.

A jiangshi that runs while blowing smoke from its head. People's screams. Sergeant Kim shouting. Jung Heewon hurriedly turned around. In order to prevent the jiangshi reaching out toward Jung Eunho from happening again, I changed the order of the sentences, changed the words, and wrote new sentences over and over again.

And I thought.

How many times did this incident happen in 'Ways of Survival'?

How many times did Jung Eunho die here, and how many times did Jung Heewon lose her younger brother here?

And.

「How many times did Jung Heewon have to become a 'Mad Butcher'?」

As I moved my gaze, my eyes met someone who happened to be standing near Jung Eunho.

In this eternity, only the two of us were looking at each other and thinking the same thing.

I don't know him.

How old he is, where he lives, what he likes.

I don't know anything.

All I know is he read this story

I reached out for him.

I wanted to shout. Tried to tell him to stop.

An explosion occurred with a roar, and people around the stage flew through the air and fell to the floor.

With the sound of heavy breathing, the speed of time returned to normal.

「This story is still 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.」

And Jung Heewon and I ran towards Jung Eunho at the same time.

「Therefore, written for only one reader.」

In the white dust, I saw Jung Eunho's skull mask that had fallen to the floor.

Jung Heewon called Jung Eunho by name.

「It was completed at the sacrifice of only one reader at the same time.」

A man was holding Jung Eunho tightly. The man's face was covered in blood.

All the flesh on his back had been ripped off, and the organs that had been burned to expose the bones had already run out of function. It was a wound that he could not survive.

Jung Heewon slumped on the ground.

I staggered over and shook him.

It can't be like this.

There is no reason why you should be like this, not anyone else.

He won't die. He has [strong bones] and [heavy bones].

The man who raised his head with difficulty was looking at Jung Heewon.

I remembered the comments he had made belatedly.

He was a man about to enlist and decided to confess to his crush.

I also remembered what I saw of him.

He was a man afraid of death.

He was a man who betrayed his fellow kinsfolk and committed himself to the Beggar Sect, and he was a sergeant who suddenly abandoned his children.

He was not Jung Heewon's father.

He just read the story, and the audience was drawn to it.

Nevertheless, on the stage of this tragedy, he said a single line he had been practicing.

"Good job, Heewon-ya."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 640 Episode 17 A Storm in a Teacup (1)

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「Anna Croft said.」

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Maybe the regression turns you and I built up were just like a storm in a teacup. Our years of struggling for dozens of rounds couldn't change a single sliver of the night sky."

Then, Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at the stars in the night sky reflected on the teacup with silent eyes.

"One day, the moment will come when all the stars in the sky will fall and I will be left alone in this world. Even then, if I'm holding this cup."

Yoo Joonghyuk emptied all the remaining tea as if swallowing the night sky reflected in the tea water.

"At that time, the world would have changed."」

—Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World

---

This was the second time I had seen someone die right in front of my eyes.

Whoever reads this story dies.

The brilliance in his eyes dimmed, and his body temperature cooled. It becomes an eye that can no longer read anything.

Spirit of Elaine Forest, Holy Oil, Summoning team or whatever.

There’s no use. It's too late.

It was a wound that could not be revived even if I had an elixir.

I know.

Even so, I couldn't stand it if I didn't even think about it. If I don't think like that, I will think of something else.

I blankly looked down at my hands. Just before, when I wrote a sentence, my hand was stained red.

"Dad."

Jung Heewon said. Jung Heewon spoke in a low voice while holding Sergeant Jung Moonho's hand, which was cold.

"Wake up. This isn't it."

If you say that, it's as if he'd really wake up again.

However, Sergeant Jung Moonho could not open his eyes again.

The story with a 90% success rate of reproduction was reproduced that way.

「Sergeant Jung Moonho is dead.」

All I could do was record this moment.

「Jung Heewon was crying.」

The body of Sergeant Jung Moonho, who had passed away, melted into the demonic energy of the defect explosion and was completely crushed.

I wanted to ask.

Why did you risk your life for this child?

Maybe I know the answer to why you jumped in for a character you have no connection with.

「Because he is a fragment of Kim Dokja.」

In the place where Sergeant Jung Moonho's body disappeared, I saw a slowly emerging soul.

「Kkoma Kim Dokja.」

I witnessed a similar phenomenon when Jung Jaewoo died in the theater dungeon.

Even then, the pitch-black space split, and the white hand snatched Jung Jaewoo's soul.

However.

What appeared this time was a black hand.

The black hand that jumped out in an instant seized the soul of the kkoma Kim Dokja as it is, leaving the space.

It disappeared through the cracks of the space.

A white hand last time.

A black hand this time.

I couldn't understand. What kind of beings take away the souls of dead readers?

Is this the RepresentativeKimDokja I saw at the banquet then? Or is it the Outer God that appeared this time?

Why were we brought to this world?

「It was finally the ending of the story the reader wanted.」

This kind of story that no one would want, why the hell did it have to continue? My vision flickered as if it was dark, and the swirling emotions were sucking me in like sand.

[Exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' is activated!]

And there was a story that still protected me.

「Yoo Joonghyuk said. "Okay."」

Yoo Joonghyuk of 'Ways of Survival' was talking. Listening to Yoo Joonghyuk's voice, which I don't even know how many times I heard, I managed to get rid of my stomach-churning feeling.

「"If you don't give up, there is a way."」

Reading and re-reading that sentence, I muttered to myself as if brainwashing myself.

Yoo Joonghyuk is right.

Even if their soul is kidnapped by an Outer God, there is a way to get it back.

「Like Kim Dokja, who was kidnapped by a 'Secretive Plotter', returned.」

Jung Heewon, who had stopped crying before I knew it, was collecting all the belongings of Sergeant Jung Moonho.

"Inho-ssi. Is there any way to save him?"

An infinitely calm, still, high-pitched voice. I also gathered my energy and answered her words.

"Yes."

As I looked up into the air, a message flew in as if it had been waiting for it.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' sponsors you 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'King Heungmu the Great' sponsors you 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' sponsors you 100 coins.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' sponsors you 1,000 coins.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks what happened to the Outer God.]

[Your first story is about to bloom.]

[The <Star Stream> is evaluating your first story.]

['Bounty Scenario - Fight' has ended.]

[You get a low-grade elixir as a reward.]

The reward of the 'Bounty Scenario' that came with a huge coin sponsorship.

I immediately opened the wooden box that came down from the air.

The elixir contained in the wooden box was something I was familiar with.

'Manindan.'

Will this elixir work even if I give it to him?

I immediately called Bihyung via Dokkaebi communication.

'Is the reward worth it? Honestly, it wasn't a scenario that would end with such a reward.'

It was not a different existence, it was a scenario completed by defeating an Outer God. However, it doesn't make sense to say that the only reward is a 'manindan'.

Fortunately, the answer came right away.

—It's already being discussed at the management bureau. I also put a word in it. I guess it will take some time.

It seems that Bihyung is also having a lot of trouble with this 'Outer God' situation.

Heck, since the Outer World appeared before the fifth scenario even started, there must have been an uproar in the management office by now.

Jung Heewon, who saw the manindan, asked.

"Is that a cure?"

"This alone is not enough."

Manindan is a low-grade elixir of the 'Forty Dan', a product of the Murim tournament.

The efficacy of the elixir itself is reduced, but if he eats it as it is, Jung Eunho will literally go crazy and become a demon.

In order to neutralize the demon corps, at least a mild elixir equivalent to the demon dan's performance was needed.

"Sister..."

Jung Eunho, who came to his senses, struggled to open his eyelids. Jung Heewon held his brother's hand.

"Eunho-ssi, it’s okay."

"Dad…"

"It's okay, breathe. Don't think about anything else."

Reaching out her hand and covering her brother's eyelids, Jung Heewon looked back at me. Now I really don't have much time left. If it's delayed here, Jung Eunho won't be able to heal even with the magic medicine.

I got up from my seat and went up to the rain stage.

There was still a way.

I had coins left over, and if I had to, I could have bought the elixir even with a higher amount by opening the 'Exchange' instead of 'Dokkaebi bag'.

If fewer constellations were watching me, I would have thought of that method.

[The constellation 'Shi Huangdi, who dreamed of immortality' proposes a contract with you, he can give you a simple elixir.]

[The constellation 'A Loan Shark Aiming For The Heart' says that you can exchange 100,000 coins for a summons' class elixir.]

Damn kids.

If I use the 'exchange' now, I will be able to buy elixirs at ridiculous prices.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' argues that he is such a ridiculous profiteer.]

[The constellation 'Merchant of the Daedong River' holds his tongue saying that there are people worse than him.]

Fortunately, the worst was not assumed.

I climbed onto the stage and looked at the dragon head ark and the meteorite guarded by the envoys.

「Green.」

As mentioned in the ORV, meteorites have different contents depending on their color.

The 'yellow meteorite' contains a guide to prepare for disasters, the 'bright red meteorite' contains weapons, and the 'black red meteorite' contains material resources.

However, this meteorite from another world had a faint bluish-green color.

As I remember, the green meteorites contain return items related to the 'scenario'.

I once again reviewed the contents of 'Omniscient Reader' and ordered the 'Thought' to change into 'Broken Faith'.

['Thoughts of almost everything' defies your command.]

Maybe it's because it was overworked today?

This guy didn't listen.

[You can't use Incite for 10 minutes as a penalty.]

Due to the penalty, [Incite] is also unusable.

I picked up an abandoned baton on the floor and blew into it.

Can I break a meteorite with this?

I honestly had no confidence. It was because my limbs were in a state of not listening to the reaction of [Incite].

"Can I break it?"

When I turned my head, Jung Heewon who had approached me was standing next to me.

"I will do it."

Before I could nod my head, Jung Heewon picked up the 'Mikazuki Munezika' that had fallen on the floor.

Soon after, an unusual magical energy began to run through Jung Heewon's body.

[A deep madness overflows from Jung Heewon.]

A strange heat radiated from her calm expression. Eyes that give you goosebumps just by looking at them. Without any hesitation, her blade cut down the meteorite vertically.

Kagagak.

Even though it was a meteorite of considerable size, her swordsmanship neatly cut the meteorite in two.

Looking closely, a black and faint aura flowed through her whole body.

[A new characteristic of the character Jung Heewon is wriggling.]

She has already awakened as the 'Judge of the Ten Demons'. However, another characteristic evolution was taking place inside her.

It was clear what she would become as a result of this evolution.

'The Mad Butcher.'

In the end, Sergeant Jung Moonho's death left a deep scar in Jung Heewon's heart. That was a bad sign.

「While Yoo Joonghyuk's return was repeated, 'Mad Butcher' never made a friend. She was always alone, and in the end she died alone. No one in the world tried to understand her madness, and no one understood her either.」

I don't want Jung Heewon to be like that. To do that, I must save Jung Eunho.

Passsss.

At the spot where the meteorites had scattered, a black wooden box was raised.

A wooden box made of much better material than the one received as a scenario reward.

As soon as I opened the lid, a brilliant golden light flowed out.

Inside the meteorite, there were three eggs of 'Summoning Team'.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is relieved by your luck.]

[The constellation 'Emperor Shi Huang, Who Dreamed of Immortality' is protesting to the Administration, saying that something is wrong!]

Shaolin's Arcane Elixir, Summoning Team.

If you think about it, the luck that came from the <3rd Murim>.

Since it was a meteorite, there was nothing strange about this amount of compensation.

"Inho-ssi."

"Yes. I think this will work."

Together with Jung Heewon, I immediately helped Jung Eunho and made him sit up on the floor.

"It might be uncomfortable, but bear with it."

Jung Eunho's condition was more serious than expected. All the skin and organs through which the bullet fragments penetrated were poisoned, and some tissues had already suffered severe necrosis.

It was amazing that this little child had suppressed the pain until now.

It was the application of Kim Dokja's mixing of 'Forty Dan' and 'Daehwandan' in 'Omniscient Reader'.

[Some of the medicinal ingredients are mixed to neutralize the toxicity.]

With the dim light, Jung Eunho's complexion began to quickly return.

No matter how severe the wounds are, it is eventually a physical wound.

If the basic story wasn't damaged, there was a possibility that he could fully recover with the power of the elixir.

Did it last like 5 minutes?

Jung Eunho's body suddenly began to convulse.

I hurriedly checked Jung Eunho's veins.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' is silently gazing at the incarnation 'Jeong Eunho'.]

Belatedly, I thought I wanted to go to sleep.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' says that the boy is not yet ready to accept the elixir.]

It was a symptom commonly referred to as schizophrenia.

「In the case of the intoxication caused by the side effects of the elixir, there are two solutions. One is that, according to heavenly luck, the person involved in the orgasm will attain enlightenment. The second one is to deal with the runaway magic.」

A phrase from the 'Ways of Survival' that came to mind naturally.

"Heewon-ssi. It seems that I and Heewon-ssi will have to help."

I briefly explained the situation to Jung Heewon.

In fact, the solution introduced in 'Ways of Survival' was possible only for the masters of Murim.

But as of now, there was no other master.

We held each other's hands tightly, and each held onto Jung Eunho's hands.

And.

Deed deed deed.

Just as an ocean current flows into a river through tributaries, Jung Eunho's magic power rushed wildly through my fingers.

It felt like the clogged blood vessels had been released, and all the mana in the body that had not been used was boiling.

I instinctively sensed it. If we can overcome this difficulty, I, Jung Heewon, and maybe Jung Eunho will be much stronger than before.

The problem is, if we don't get through this, all three of us will die.

I endured the pain that pushed through my teeth.

Koo-goo-goo-goo!

We didn't say anything to each other, but we didn't let go of our hands until the end.

The complexion of Jung Heewon, whose magical power level was low, was getting tired.

I too was a little nervous. Jung Eunho's mana, which I thought would calm down quickly, was tireless.

Cold sweat broke out all over my body, and my vision darkened as if mold had grown in my eyes.

A reality I did not want to admit raised its head.

「Jung Eunho cannot be saved.」

It was brief, but a dazzling temptation arose. If we let go even now, we will suffer serious internal injuries, but we may be able to save Jung Heewon. However, Jung Eunho and I will die.

It was absurd when it came to this.

It is as if some great destiny is at work.

「It seemed that someone was somehow trying to turn Jung Heewon into the Mad Butcher.」

As if she had read my thoughts, Jung Heewon held my hand tightly with her demon-like eyes shining.

I regretted it belatedly. If only I had learned at least a basic healing skill...

Jung Heewon's body was leaning as blood poured from her nose and mouth.

The moment I became desperate and tried to extend my hand to save Jung Heewon.

[Your new story will emerge!]

[Story, 'the tenacious Murim master' begins the story.]

Just as a real Murim master uses his own magic, Jung Eunho's magic was put on hold. The skill of controlling the flow of magical power with a strong spirit. Following the story told by the tale, magic began to flow through the energy and blood.

I quickly figured out whose story this was.

「It was the story given by the ark.」

A story of the essence of martial arts experienced by the Ark, from being a human to becoming a constellation.

The flow of mana, which had been racing like a runaway engine, gradually calmed down, and the complexions of Jung Heewon and Jung Eunho gradually became more comfortable.

As the flow of magical power subsided, Jung Eunho's agony could be heard.

"Sister. Sorry."

Jung Heewon replied.

"Are you okay."

What is sorry and what is okay? I don't know, but the two of them crossed a boundary with it. He lost his father and accepted the fact that he had to live in this world.

「And writer Lee Hakhyun recorded all these stories.」

I suddenly became curious.

These sentences that I often think of, where the hell do they come from?

Could it be the 'Ways of Survival'? Is it 'Omniscient Reader'?

Could it be the 'Fourth Wall'? Will it be the 'Last Wall'?

If not that.

「Do you want to know?」

I would like to know.

Even though I thought I shouldn't lose consciousness, little by little my eyes darkened.

I fell into a deep drowsiness, and after a while I heard the sound of someone waking me up.

And when I opened my eyes again.

「You're here again.」

I was lying on the white snowfield.

I saw a person wearing a pure white coat.

I called his name.

「Kim Dokja.」

As if he knew what had happened, he looked down at me with a somewhat forlorn look.

「Drink.」

He held out the teacup he was holding. Warm steam was rising from the teacup.

「It was prepared by Yoo Joonghyuk from the 81st round.」

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 81st turn.

As I remember, Yoo Joonghyuk is good at cooking.

I got up and took the teacup. I drank a sip.

It's good.

My stomach warmed up, my anxious heart subsided little by little, and peace came to me.

He can make something like this.

I guess so. Because Kim Dokja is 'The Oldest Dream'.

He is the god of this world, and whatever he imagines becomes reality, so the hand holding the cup trembled lightly.

Kim Dokja looked at me without saying a word.

Clearly everything was peaceful.

Even so, in this peaceful world between the lines, I felt a slightly different feeling than usual.

The water in the teacup shook.

People could be seen above the shaking tea water. Someone screamed, someone howled.

Among them was Jung Heewon's face, and Jung Moonho's face. There was the face of Jung Jaewoo, and there was also the face of the Ark.

I asked Kim Dokja, holding the teacup with both hands, fearing that they would spill over.

「Why on earth are you… still having dreams like this?」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 641 Episode 17 A Storm in a Teacup (2)

In response to my reply, Kim Dokja was silent for a moment. I felt strange.

Was there ever a time when Kim Dokja felt unfamiliar like now?

He has always been a friendly protagonist.

He represents the readers, defeating villains, fooling enemies with overwhelming information, and sacrificing himself to protect his comrades.

He became a constellation by collecting five stories, and he was the one who saw the end of the scenario by collecting all the 'great stories of victory and battle'.

A man who chose eternity himself to protect the world and became 'the oldest dream'.

He was talking.

「Can you dream when you want to dream?」

I was speechless for a moment.

Is there anyone who can dream when they want to dream?

When I shook my head, Kim Dokja said.

「So neither can I.」

The Oldest Dream, an all-knowing but incompetent God. I remembered the words Kim Dokja expressed when he was young.

「I am not a person who dreams only of what I want. I just dream of everything in the universe.」

Having said that, Kim Dokja turned his head and looked at the scenery of the snowy field.

I was looking at the same scenery.

For a moment I was scared.

Kim Dokja, is he really seeing the same scenery as I am? How many years have passed since the day he first became the Oldest Dream?

Is the Kim Dokja in front of me really the Kim Dokja I remember?

「You don’t have to deal with that.」

I was talking involuntarily.

「That’s why Han Sooyoung wrote the novel. To make everyone dream the dream you dreamed. So, to free you from this eternity.」

Kim Dokja nodded meekly.

「But I'm the only one watching this 'world' right now.」

This world.

That must be the meaning of the 41st turn of 'Ways of Survival'.

Kim Dokja asked me.

「Do you think it would be better for this world to disappear?」

In the world of the <Star Stream>, stories that no one reads disappear.

Just as an incarnation that has not received the gaze of any star dies alone.

「I…」

It was a question that was not easy to answer.

Is it right that the world where tragedy is predestined does not begin in the first place?

After thinking for a while, I came up with an answer.

「I don’t know if it was really a convolution, but it’s a world that actually exists. If it's a world that's destined for destruction, if it's a world where sorrow outweighs joy—」

「Isn’t it better not to?」

I couldn't help but nod my head.

Even if the end is a tragedy, there will surely be various joys and sorrows in that world.

Someone will find their own happiness in that world of destruction.

I know. I know, but I also had something to say.

「Someone is dead. There are people who died because of this story.」

Readers who were outside the story were drawn into the story. Even now, the faces of Jung Jaewoo and Sergeant Jung Moonho, who were dying, were not forgotten.

Then Kim Dokja replied.

「But someone might have lived thanks to that story.」

It felt like having cold water poured over my head.

Kim Dokja, who was telling the story, was definitely on the 'alive' side.

Because he survived by reading Han Sooyoung's 'Ways of Survival'.

「Should this story still not have started?」

I couldn't say anything.

Anyone would have been the same.

No one can say to the boy who grew up through that misfortune, "You were the one who had to die."

I thought about Han Sooyoung, who wrote the 1,863 turns in 'Ways of Survival' and the dokkaebi king. She said the story will begin even if she doesn't write it, but the Dokkaebi King didn't tell her how the story would begin.

And Han Sooyoung most certainly knew a story that could help 'Kim Dokja' survive.

She wrote it, and Kim Dokja read it. Yoo Joonghyuk lived the story and the three people met.

A world where the beginning, the middle, and the end interlock. A circular universe where it is unknown who existed first.

In front of a chain of causes and effects that seemed to bite their tails as if it were natural, I didn't know where to begin and how to cover the wrongs.

When I raised my head, I saw Kim Dokja's face.

「Some stories are sad, some stories are funny. There are heartbreaking stories, and there are stories that I can't stand because I'm curious about the next chapter.」

As if a story only he could see was embroidered in the distant sky.

Kim Dokja was looking up at the sky.

「Is a sad story bad, and a happy story good? How about a sad and happy story? Is a story of predestined destruction meaningless?」

I blankly listened to that.

「In a universe that was born of tragedy from the beginning, it would have been better if it did not exist.」

Only then did I seem to know a little bit of what Kim Dokja was talking about.

Maybe it wasn't just the story of the <Star Stream>.

The universe I lived in was the same.

No one in the world knew the birth and end of the universe. Even in a world without scenarios, people suffered. They died of war or starvation, hated each other or killed

each other. People were either happy or sad, and found hope in despair.

And everyone met their own demise.

How can we say that the universe is different from this universe, and how and to whom should we ask the sins that the universe started? Is it possible to ask such a thing in the first place?

As if to answer me, Kim Dokja said.

「We are all in longing. Life and death are just stories in it. It's like a starlight shining in a distant universe for an instant.」

I know what that means.

But I was too ordinary a human being to accept that. I am afraid of death. I hate being sad. It's scary when someone disappears, so i wanted to run away

from the coming destruction. From the fact that neither this universe, nor the <Star Stream>, nor anything else is eternal.

「There is no unfinished story.」

Unlike me, Kim Dokja accepted and understood that fact. To him, the three ways were just stories.

Happy or sad, it was all just stories to him.

He has read the story and is reading. He existed like that.

For so many years I can't possibly imagine.

「You… Are you really the Kim Dokja I know?」

Maybe he wanted Kim Dokja to lie.

I wanted him to still be the main character of this story.

He grins as usual, hoping he'll tell me that he'll figure it out somehow, so we'll see the end of this scenario together.

「If you think so.」

My stomach rumbled. Could it be because of dizziness? Kim Dokja, who was standing in the snowy field in a clear shape, looked somewhat blurry. There was the feeling of darkness lurking deep in my head wriggling.

I stumbled and asked.

「Why did we come here? Me and the other readers , for what reasondid we come?」

Kim Dokja did not answer.

Just like the first time I saw him, he just stared at me with a sad smile.

I couldn't express it well, but I knew it the moment I saw that smile.

My question is a question that Kim Dokja cannot answer.

「You can’t tell me?」

There will be several reasons. It could be because of probability, or it could be because of the specificity of this space.

In the first place, something was strange about this snowy field.

When I came here, I felt like I was in a fairy tale.

Fairy tales had a way of speaking suitable for fairy tales, so I used to speak like a character in a fairy tale.

A world where accurate stories cannot be exchanged. A place where everything exists as metaphors and symbols.

I remembered that 'snowfield' was a metaphor for 'between the lines'.

Although nothing is written, in fact, it’s the place where all the truth is revealed, Kim Dokja said.

「Everything I know is a story you know too.」

「…You who are now in front of me are not the real you, right?」

Kim Dokja smiled silently.

When you think about it, it was a story that made no sense.

Kim Dokja was the Oldest Dream, and he was scattered as fragments of the universe.

Even if he had come back, it would not have been possible for me to face such a great person and speak properly.

So Kim Dokja met me through an expedient.

Kim Dokja replied in an ambiguous voice.

「We are the ones who create the stories, but at the same time, the stories are also using us. The answer you want will be revealed when you complete your story.」

「What was the answer you found? You've already read 'Ways of Survival'.」

「I have read all of it, and I have not read all of it.」

I blankly opened my mouth.

All stories have already been written, and are being written at the same time. If that is Kim Dokja's answer, I might have something left to say.

「You asked me earlier if there is no meaning to a story in which the end is fixed.」

Kim Dokja nodded his head. I looked down at my feet and said.

「I don't know the answer to your question yet. But I know at least one thing.」

The tragedy of the 41st turn was written in 'Omniscient Reader'. This world ends in misfortune, and it is said to be one of the most terrible worlds among Yoo Joonghyuk's numerous rounds.

「I will stop the tragedy of this world.」

I thought of the readers who entered this world. I thought of Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Killer King and Literature Girl 64, Ye Hyunwoo, Goo Seonah, and Kim Kyungsik.

「I will see the end of this world.」

Jung Heewon, who lost her father at the same time. It reminded me of Yoo Joonghyuk who felt that pain resembled in the terrible regressions.

「Even if that results in more world lines being changed, I will struggle to the end no matter what.」

I understand the feelings of Han Sooyoung, who had no choice but to use the 'Ways of Survival' to save Kim Dokja.

Perhaps my choice may lead to a greater cosmic tragedy. Some people will criticize and point fingers at me. Maybe those people will cry.

However, since I am not the Oldest Dream, I cannot dream and worry about such a big universe.

All I can see is the world in front of my eyes. People who read my story and live this story. Just a small happiness in front of their eyes that will disappear like a thread.

「Cheon Inho.」

Kim Dokja said.

「No, Lee Hakhyun.」

I raised my head involuntarily.

There was Kim Dokja.

The Kim Dokja I knew.

The person who loves stories more than anyone else was talking to me.

「This time, tell me a happy story.」

---

[Exiting from the snow field.]

As soon as I opened my eyes, what I saw was the sky over Seoul Station. And for me, there have been some changes.

[The <Star Stream> noticed your presence.]

[Your '□□' skill is subject to probability restrictions from now on.]

[Some functions of the skill will be sealed until your qualifications are met.]

[The 'failures' you collected have been recorded on the final wall.]

[Failures collected so far: 2.]

['The Final Wall' recognizes your contributions.]

[Your exclusive skill evolves!]

[You will receive additional benefits whenever the number of 'failures' increases.]

[You have achieved an achievement that does not exist.]

[Your new story is created.]

Feeling the power of the rising story, I looked up at the night sky of Seoul Station.

A myriad of stars and darkness were mixed in the night sky. Watching the scattering of light, I involuntarily opened my mouth.

This world was written and not written at the same time.

The starlight in the sky came from a distance of hundreds of millions of light years. Among them, the most dazzling star might have already disappeared a long time ago. The death of the brightest star right now may not yet be visible to me.

The original light that clearly exists, but has not yet been recorded in this sky.

As Kim Dokja said, the ending of this universe may be predetermined.

Even so, this story has only just begun, and I have a sentence left to write.

So I will write.

[Fable, 'Recorder of things that will disappear', has been born.]

「This world hasn’t ended yet.」

Even after all that, I still liked this story.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 642 Episode 17 A Storm in a Teacup (3)

The next morning, I called the people of Seoul Station together.

In a cluttered atmosphere, people were looking up at me as I stood on the stage.

The beggars who followed the ark, and the soldiers who followed Sergeant Jung Moonho.

The spotted boy and the boy's father, Myung Sewoon, were also seen.

Myung Sewoon was now completely freed from the restraints of the ark.

—Thank you very much, Inseok-ah. How should I repay this favor?

—Thank you, brother.

They were greeted early in the morning.

The Dragon Head Ark was still behind him, but he wouldn't abuse him as a possessed body like before.

Because he saw the story he wanted here.

[In the middle of the night, 67 incarnations left your group.]

[With the power of the purple flag, you can trigger 'punishment' on those people.]

Looking around, the overall number of people was much lower than yesterday.

I didn't bother punishing the fugitives. It was because I wondered what would be the point of holding on to people who would leave anyway.

I looked around at each of the people gathered and slowly opened my mouth.

"I'll tell you frankly."

There were still around two hundred incarnations left here.

I gave a plausible answer to the Ark, but honestly, I didn't have the confidence to lead them all.

"I can't be responsible for all of you. I can't even tell you that it's safe to stay with my group. If you want to leave, you can go. There will be no separate [punishment]. If you wish, please leave the station right now."

People were very upset by my remarks. I could hear the beggars openly giggling.

"Let's go. I don't think it's here."

"I heard that there are good groups in Dongdaemun and Dobong Station right now. All the beggars in that area have fallen for Dobonggu."

I don't know about Dongdaemun, but if it's Dobonggu, I can guess.

That is where the tyrant king is.

"The new ark is pretty strong too."

"It was just luck. My sponsor said that the skill he saw was just like that."

"Wasn't the woman with the sword quite strong then? That person seemed like an underling."

Jung Heewon, who had not yet regained consciousness, was asleep in the tent provided by Sergeant Kim.

Fortunately, Jung Heewon's internal injuries were not serious. Rather, since she absorbed the energy of the elixir, she will be much stronger than before when she wakes

up.

Jung Eunho, who woke up earlier than his sister, could be seen sticking his head out of the tent.

"Even if you stay here, you'll just die like a dog. Leaders are more important in an era like this."

"That's right. You have to be under someone who is strong and has leadership. That young man... Honestly, he looks a bit like a cheater."

Public opinion at Seoul Station was gradually divided. About half of the total number of beggars decided to leave.

Among them, their representative smiled and bowed her head.

"Representative, then we're done..."

I nodded lightly and let them go.

Most of them were middle-aged men. The incarnations with the strongest fighting power at the present time. It was a power that could be regretted if it was regrettable.

On the other hand, those who remained were mostly young people or old people who had no place to rely on.

In a sense, these were the real 'Beggar Sect'.

"What about the remaining people...?"

It was the girl who was with Jung Eunho who raised her hand and asked.

Children who plundered adults.

Kids with nowhere to go were watching me.

"The remaining people will become members of my group. The name of Seoul Station group was originally the Beggar Sect, so those who are here can continue to work under the Beggar Sect."

The Beggar Sect created by the ark will continue to exist in this scenario.

A faint look of disappointment spread in the children's eyes.

"Then, again we—"

"However, the new Beggar Sect will no longer turn children into predators."

At my words, the children's eyes widened.

"The new Beggar Sect will not continue the old way. The Beggar Sect is no longer a beggar's organization. If there are people who remain thinking about the old Beggar Sect, I hope they will leave the station immediately."

Another dozen people left the station.

I opened my mouth to the rest.

"As you are probably aware, you cannot survive by begging in this new world. The constellations do not give anything away for free."

"So, what do we do now?"

"Build your own story."

The group members looked puzzled, as if asking what that meant.

Well, these people still don't even know what a 'story' is. In the meantime, building a 'story' would be no different from advising young children who don't know anything to 'have your own dream big'.

They need to slowly learn what it means to build a story and what it means to have your own story.

What I can do now is teach them how to hold a pen so they can write their first sentence.

"Let's start by eating rice."

At my signal, Sergeant Kim and the soldiers appeared at the entrance of Seoul Station. They were carrying food made outside. It was 'Tangkangju Barbecue' and 'Soup' made with the heat of the magic furnace.

Fascinated by the smell, people flocked with exclamations. Everyone probably hadn't had a proper meal since the beginning of the scenario.

"We'll distribute meals, so everyone line up at the front!"

Under the direction of Sergeant Kim, the cooks began distributing rations.

I also received a barbecue and a plate of soup from Sergeant Kim.

"You're good at it."

"No. Originally, I did some cooking."

Sergeant Kim laughed as if he was embarrassed, and he also picked up a piece of meat and mumbled.

It was this morning that I asked Sergeant Kim to cook.

As soon as I woke up, I bought monster parts that were on the market at a low price through the exchange, and asked Sergeant Kim and the cooks to make breakfast for people.

"Rather than that, how did you know this recipe?"

"A kid I know told me."

The recipe for the monster followed the recipe of Yoo Joonghyuk, the best cook in 'Ways of Survival'. Indeed, like Yoo Joonghyuk, who was sincere in cooking, a great dish was born with only the basic ingredients.

"Jam, did you put the elixir I gave you in the cooking?"

"Yes, of course."

The peculiarity of this dish is that the sauce is mixed with Murim's Elixir.

"But those elixirs... are they left by the ark?"

"Yes that's right."

Myung Sewoon is the father of the spotted boy who came to visit me early in the morning.

'100 Years of Roots' was handed over.

I recognized right away that this was the elixir the ark originally intended to give me.

However, Jung Eunho's internal injuries have already been cured.

After thinking about it for a while, I decided to put all three roots of the 100-year-old sewage plant in a dish and feed it to the group members.

"Wow, it's really good. Can I have another bowl?"

"President Park. It seems that your biceps suddenly got bigger."

“Heh heh, I’m kidding."

The faces of the chattering people were much brighter than before.

'100 Years Old Root' is the elixir that the ark left for the Beggar Sect. I also had two summoning pills left, so I wanted to use these elixirs to improve the survivability of the group members.

[The constellations from Murim admire your actions.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' nods at your thoughtfulness.]

[1,000 coins were sponsored.]

The group members who ate a hearty breakfast after a long time looked more comfortable than before.

When everyone had properly emptied their bowls, I opened my mouth again.

"To all of you who are left here, I will teach you the skills and hunting methods necessary for survival."

Of course, I didn't mean to teach my skills. I had no skills to teach in the first place.

Fortunately, the Beggar Sect possesses skills at Seoul Station.

The room's skills were stockpiled in large quantities.

It seems that he tried to teach it in earnest when the degree of the Beggar Sect grew a little more.

Although the Beggar Sect’s martial arts were a few steps behind Kyrgios's [All-In-One] or the Impenetrable Swordsman's [Pajeon-Geomdoe], they were still skills that could reach the pinnacle of <Murim> with constant training.

"Sergeant Kim."

"Yes."

Sergeant Kim, who learned martial arts from the skill book given to me in advance, showed a light demonstration of martial arts while holding a baton.

Then, the people sitting in the front row vomited exclamations.

The martial art used only by the Ark.

Now everyone can learn that martial art.

Sergeant Kim cleared his throat lightly and opened his mouth.

"From now on, I will become a martial arts instructor and teach you skills, or help you learn skills."

People looked at each other in disbelief. It was a look that somehow lacked confidence.

"We… Can we really learn something like that?"

"No problem. I got used to it in one day."

Both children and the elderly can become strong in this world if they set their minds to it.

The beggars, who have lived their lives entrusted to a group, needed the conviction that they could change themselves if they worked hard.

「Soon there will be a war for the absolute throne in Gwanghwamun.」

When the time comes, they must be at the forefront of the scenario, whether they like it or not.

I don't know how many of them will be able to live in that world, but I still wanted to leave a little spark here.

Of course, this story won't change much if there is one Beggar Sect.

Just because a few of these people practice martial arts, learn skills, and gain mastery, there is no way that an impossible scenario will suddenly become possible.

Everything is just a storm in a teacup, and the ending of the 41st turn may not change.

"One! Two! One! Two!"

Nonetheless, watching the children imitate the moves, I thought for a long time about the waves swirling in the empty teacup and Yoo Joonghyuk who had repeated his life over 1,863 times.

Obviously, the lives of the characters in the story may not ultimately change.

But anyone who reads their story will have their world changed.

At least I believe so.

---

"For the time being, I will leave Seoul Station to Sergeant Kim."

"Are you sure you're okay with me?"

I nodded.

"Sergeant Kim also trusted me and entrusted his flag to me."

Sergeant Kim handed over the 'red flag' he had to me.

[Using the representative's own authority.]

[Seoul Station representative Cheon Inho transferred part of the authority to group member 'Kim Heonyeol'.]

[Group member 'Kim Heonyeol' became the 'sub-representative of Seoul Station'.]

[In the future, group member 'Kim Heonyeol' can punish group members on behalf of the representative.]

From the purple flag, you can appoint as many deputy representatives as you want.

If Sergeant Jung Moonho were alive, he would have been entrusted with the role, but for now, this person was the best.

**<Character information>**

Name: Kim Heonyeol

Age: 33

Sponsor: None (currently, 1 constellation is showing interest).

Attribute: Righteous Soldier (Rare)

Exclusive skills: [Swordsmanship Lv.3], [Camouflage Lv.1], [Sense of Justice Lv.2], [Comrades in arms Lv.1], [Leadership Lv.1]

Stigma: None.

Overall stats: [Stamina Lv.23], [Strength Lv.21], [Agility Lv.20], [Magic Power Lv.19]

Overall assessment: A comprehensive assessment has not yet been described.

Righteous soldier. Somehow, that characteristic reminded me of Lee Hyunsung, which made me choose this person as the vice-president.

Sergeant Kim should be able to manage the station well until Jung Heewon wakes up.

"Are you really going to leave like this? Wouldn't it be nice to go with Heewon-ssi when she wakes up?"

Originally, I waited a bit before moving on.

However, the delay near Seoul Station was long, and above all, the hidden scenario had already arrived.

[Hidden scenario has arrived!]

['King's Road' begins!]

**<Hidden Scenario - King's Road>**

Category: Hidden

Difficulty: A

Clear conditions: Reach the 'Black Flag' within the time limit.

Time limit: 10 days

Reward: King's qualifications.

Failure: If the conditions are not fulfilled within the time period, you and all members of your group will be killed.

The content of the scenario are slightly different from the main story of 'Omniscient Reader'.

To be precise, I would say that the difficulty has become higher than it was then.

From now on, not only my life but also the lives of my group members were on my shoulders.

[A new king candidate has started walking his own path!]

Fortunately, the number of stations occupied by the ark and those occupied by Sergeant Kim were quite large.

[Current occupied areas: Seoul Station (main camp), Chungjeongno Station, Aeogae Station, Namyeong Station, City Hall Station, Samgak Area, Hyochang Park Station, Sookmyung University Station...]

[A total of 12 stations are occupied.]

It has already occupied as many as 12 stations.

And yet, the color of my flag was still purple.

How many more flags must be acquired in the future to create a 'black flag'?

I do not know either.

In any case, I now have to contend with the role of a representative.

And for me, the final destination was decided.

「Gwanghwamun.」

I'll have to go quickly.

Above all, there was someone who I was supposed to meet there.

"Hyung."

When I turned around, Jung Heewon's younger brother Jung Eunho was looking up at me.

I lightly tapped Jung Eunho on the shoulder and said, "Take good care of your sister."

The point is, Jung Eunho looked at me with an expression that he didn't know what to do, then silently nodded and let go of his hand. Behind him I could see the spotted boy and other children coming out to see me off.

I waved lightly at the children.

Jung Eunho and the children will be the protagonists of future scenarios.

I just hope that the aspirations of this world will be delayed even a little so that they can explore their own stories for a little longer.

After saying goodbye like that, I was walking around Seoul Station when the cell phone in my arms suddenly rang.

—Inho-ssi. Where are you?

When I opened my phone, I saw Ye Hyunwoo's name. We exchanged numbers when we parted just in case, but it seemed that the Internet had somehow stopped working.

Just as I was about to reply, I heard an explosion from afar.

A roar like a huge building collapsing.

I quickly jumped up to a nearby high-rise building to assess the situation. Smoke was billowing in the distance.

Gwanghwamun’s side. To be precise, it was in the direction of the National Palace Museum of Korea.

—Failed to secure the 'Sword of Death'. Probably no one will be able to use the sword this time.

I blankly looked down at Ye Hyunwoo's text message.

'Failed to secure the sword of death.'

The sword of death is the sword that Kim Dokja used to destroy the 'Absolute Throne'.

Kim Dokja knew that, using the 'Absolute Throne', he would not be able to reach the correct ending. So he broke the 'absolute throne' and became himself the 'King of the Kingless World'.

However, in this turn, there is no weapon that can break the 'Absolute Throne'.

When I raised my head, the stars in the sky were swirling and brightening.

「The demise of the 41st turn begins when the owner of the 'Absolute Throne' is born.」

This story wanted the birth of a king.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 643 Episode 18 Father (1)

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「"Dad's face? I can't remember it anymore. It seems like he hasn't been there from the beginning. What about it? We have Ahjussi."」

—Beast Lord Shin Yoosung.

---

If possible, I wanted to hear more about the situation from Ye Hyunwoo, but I couldn't ask because the communication was cut off immediately.

I went straight to Gwanghwamun. Fortunately, Seoul Station and Gwanghwamun are two stops by subway.

It was a distance that could be reached in thirty minutes.

Grrr.

If only I hadn't run into that group in the middle.

Gee ying!

I mimicked the 'thought' into Broken Faith and activated 'Blade of Faith'.

Being able to regenerate such consumable items over and over again thanks to 'thought' was a big advantage.

Aaaagh!

With the lightly wielded blade of faith, the crowd quickly was cleared.

I definitely felt stronger than before.

Although there was a sudden increase in overall ability, the opportunity gained while treating Jung Eunho was great.

[Attribute 'circulation delay' is activated!]

Characteristic circulatory retardation.

In the process of enduring Jung Eunho's coin incubation together, unexpected new things were obtained.

It was a good income.

Unfortunately, it was not a well-known martial arts characteristic like the Cheonmujiche or Thai Yin-Yangjiche, but it was a useful trait for me now in terms of increasing the efficiency of magic circulation.

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' is interested in your growth rate.]

Thanks to the efficiency of the circulatory delay, it is now possible to maximize 'Broken Faith' until it is broken.

Even if I maintain the 'blade of faith' as an output, there was no lack of magic power.

After sweeping through the crowd, I looked around and spoke in a loud voice.

"Come out! You can take these!"

Then, some incarnations hiding between the building and the smoking booth secretly stuck their heads out.

As I inserted my weapon as to reassure them, a relieved incarnation approached me and asked.

"Can I really take it?"

He looked down at me with suspicious eyes.

At the beginning of the scenarios, monsters were a very useful material.

In particular, their bones can be used as a weapon that can be shot quite well if processed, so it was a monster welcomed by wanderers.

"Yes. Take it."

"Thank you..."

As the man gestured toward the back, three men appeared out of nowhere and quickly began dismantling the monster.

Even while Kim Dokja and his colleagues broke through the main scenario, most of the incarnations would have lived their lives this way.

While watching their monster dismantling process, I pointed out some dismantling points from 'Ways of Survival'.

"This place? Ah."

The man immediately nodded his head several times as if he understood what I was saying.

The man who looked at the monster’s neatly trimmed horns and said in admiration.

"You're familiar with monsters."

"I've been grooming it a few times."

Hearing that, he hesitated for a moment as if he was thinking, then looked back and cried out.

"Come out here everyone! Say hello!"

It seems that the group of men was not all three young men.

The women and children who appeared hesitantly belatedly bowed their heads in this direction.

"Thank you!"

All of them were guilty of the hard homeless life.

I wonder if there are readers among them. Should I say it was fortunate that there were no readers?

"Hey, can I ask for your name?"

"I am Cheon Inho."

"I am Kim Nakmoon. The people in the back are my friends and cousins."

"I see."

Judging from the line of movement, these are obviously incarnations from Gwanghwamun.

Maybe they know about what's going on in Gwanghwamun.

Kim Nakmoon hesitantly checked my appearance and asked in a cautious voice.

"By the way... Are you a 'king'?"

The unexpected insight surprised me a little.

"Why do you think so?"

"Aside from their ability to defeat monsters, ordinary incarnations rarely travel alone. More than anything... it seems like you're heading to Gwanghwamun."

You inferred that I was a king based on that information alone?

Did you say this person's name was Kim Nakmoon?

No matter how much I think about it, he is a character who has never appeared in the book.

「Inspector Kim Nakmoon.」

The information of the Ways of Survival naturally followed.

「The Inspector acted at Yoo Joonghyuk's subordinate in some turns with Bicheonhori.」

The text flowed in my head like a video in front of my eyes.

「"I'm sorry, Captain. I don't think I can be with you this time. I have to protect my family."」

Apparently, the man was Yoo Joonghyuk's subordinate in a certain round.

The reason why he was not chosen by Yoo Joonghyuk in this turn was probably because of his family.

"I don't know if you know, but kings from all over the world are gathering at Gwanghwamun. We're from there too."

As expected, it seemed that the kings had already begun to riot.

There were many readers who knew the future in this world.

Perhaps the kings who heard the information spread by the readers are gathering in Gwanghwamun one after another.

"I'm only saying this to my benefactor, but if possible, don't go there. The atmosphere in Gwanghwamun is unusual."

Kim Nakmoon touched the back of his trembling hand as if he was afraid of something.

"A powerful king from the Gangbuk area has united his forces. He's plotting to annihilate the rest of the kings in one fell swoop. It should have started now."

A mighty king.

I said the first name that came to mind.

"Is the king's name Yoo Joonghyuk by any chance?"

"Yoo Joonghyuk…?"

Looking at his expression, it doesn't look like it.

Well, because Yoo Joonghyuk's solo play is the rule.

Then who is it?

"I'm sorry, but I can't tell you the king's name."

Only then did I notice the faint purple sparks running through his body.

It was not a probability spark.

"Have you escaped from that king’s group?"

Traces of 'punishment' left all over the body.

These are the fugitives who took the punishment and broke away from the king's group.

Perhaps the 'King' put a special kind of restriction on the fugitives to not say his name.

Looking at Kim Nakmoon, who bowed his head in silence, I opened my mouth.

"If you have nowhere else to go, go towards Seoul Station."

"Seoul Station?"

Kim Nakmoon raised his head suddenly and asked me.

"Are you… the king of Seoul Station?"

I added my contact information—actually Cheon Inho’s contact—so that he would not be frightened.

"All you have to do is say that you came with my introduction. If you don't feel like it, you don’t have to join the group. The people there will definitely accept you without discrimination."

Kim Nakmoon, who was hesitant, bowed his head and expressed his gratitude.

Inspector Kim Nakmoon.

I don't know if he will join the Seoul Station group or not.

Either way, it wasn't a bad thing to have a relationship with this character now.

---

About 20 minutes later, I arrived safely at Gwanghwamun.

I was amazed at the scenery of the city, which was reminiscent of my memory.

I also remembered the memories of the days when I was Lee Hakhyun.

When I was majoring in literature, I often visited a large bookstore in Gwanghwamun with my university classmates.

I wonder if there are friends among my classmates who have possessed this world.

I smiled bitterly to myself and shook my head.

Probably not.

I can still vividly remember the look on their faces when I told them I was writing a web novel. They wouldn't have read it, so naturally they wouldn't be here.

Looking at the scenery in front of my eyes, I'm rather glad they're not here.

The main streets of Gwanghwamun, where protesters and riot police once stood, were now full of bloodstains from incarnations and monsters. Vehicles were lined up all over the boulevard, broken in a mess, and corpses that had not been cleaned were often seen.

There were many people killed by the monsters, but as we got closer to the center of Gwanghwamun, we could see more corpses.

After passing through the plaza and entering the road leading to the National Palace Museum, large tents began to catch my eye.

Above the tent, makeshift flags fluttered in the wind, presumably a temporary shelter built by King Magak's forces.

"What, that bastard."

The incarnations near the curtain sent a wary look toward me.

As Kim Nakmoon said, the atmosphere is flimsy.

Among them, at first glance, there were incarnations who seemed to be quite talented.

Could it be because of the awakening of the circulatory system?

Even though [Character List] was not used, I could feel the energy of the incarnations.

In particular, the incarnation who was sitting on the bench over there had an unusual energy.

A huge bow on his back and a sword on his waist.

The moment our eyes met, I realized who he was.

[The constellation 'The last hero of the Gyebaek' is watching you.]

The incarnation of Gyebaek, King Chu.

In Omniscient Reader, he was an incarnation who lost his life to Kim Dokja, but in this turn, he managed to save his life.

In addition to that, I looked at the power of the kings who had settled in various places in Gwanghwamun.

I'm sure Ji Eunyu is somewhere around here.

At the banquet, I made an appointment with her to meet her at Gwanghwamun.

But when I thought about it, Gwanghwamun was too wide.

We should have decided to meet in front of a bookstore or something specific.

I was about to call Ji Eunyu's name, but instead I thought of shouting out a password that only the two of us knew.

But what do we know?

After thinking about it for a while, I decided to give it a try.

"… Genius editor!"

For reference, genius editor is the nickname Ji Eunyu used at Kim Dokja's banquet.

Was my shout heard?

A response came from several groups who heard me.

Among them, there was one group that showed a peculiar reaction.

The man who had walked along with his gang spoke to me with a stern expression on his face.

"There bro."

Feeling a bit afraid, I asked the man.

"Ji Eunyu-ssi?"

"Hmm? What are you talking about?"

Fortunately, it wasn't Ji Eunyu.

"It's nothing. What's the matter?"

"Which group do you belong to?"

"Seoul Station."

In response to my answer, the man looked at my behavior as if he was surprised.

"Seoul Station. Where that group of beggars is located?"

The man lightly touched his chin, and he continued as if he had made up his mind.

"Come under us. You look like a runaway. With our group, we can push around Seoul Station."

"Who is the leader of your group?"

"It's King Maitreya. You must have heard of him."

King Maitreya.

Of course I know.

The incarnation of 'one-eyed Maitreya' and one of the '7 kings' of Seoul.

"What if I refuse?"

"The number of corpses will increase by one."

The men surrounded me with great momentum.

If you can't have them, you'll kill them right away.

Indeed, by the fourth scenario, is everyone saying that murder is nothing?

In the past, I would have backed away, but now I don't have any particular intention of avoiding it.

At least now, I had the confidence to fight and defeat Kim Dokja.

Since the fourth scenario has already begun, it might not be a bad idea to get the head start.

"There, wait."

It was then that a low, thick voice was heard among the men.

The man who was intimidating me muttered, "What kind of guy are you?" and turned around.

The first thing I saw was a purple flag fluttering splendidly. There were also incarnations lined up to protect the flag.

And one of them, running round and round by their side.

The puppet rat hovered around the incarnations for a long time, as if it were a joke, and then rubbed against the middle-aged man's leg near the flag.

The men who confirmed the middle-aged man's face soon shouted in frightened voices and scattered

"Bald King."

I can tell what kind of group it is just by hearing the king's name.

As I waved my hand in welcome, Ye Hyeonwoo, who was next to the bald king, ran towards me.

"Inho-ssi!"

Chungmuro Group. Fortunately, our reader seemed to have settled down safely in Gwanghwamun.

[The 'Character List' has been updated.]

The moment I saw Ye Hyunwoo, a strange message came to my mind.

[The corresponding person's update has been completed.]

[Do you want to check the person's information?]

Originally, until now, it was impossible to use [Character List] for characters possessed by readers.

"Inho-ssi. Are you okay?"

Ye Hyeonwoo, who had fully adapted to this world, was holding my hands and making a worried face.

But I couldn't help but smile at him.

Since when was it?

['List of characters' is activated]

The 7th apostle Ye Hyeonwoo became a character.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 644 Episode 18 Father (2)

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What does it mean to be a 'character' in a story?

Even in 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' there were some who suddenly became 'characters'.

For example, Lee Seongguk and Jung Minseop, who were prophets.

Together with Kim Dokja, they were characters from outside the novel, but over time they became 'characters'.

The point at which the two became 'characters' was right after the development of the scenario overtook the development of the novel they knew.

In other words, they became 'characters' the moment they passed the section where they knew what would happen.

Then, what about Ye Hyunwoo?

Unlike Lee Seongguk or Jung Minseop, he was a reader who had read 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' completely as many as 50 times.

Nonetheless, characterization occurred.

What on earth is the mechanism of characterization?

First of all, I checked Ye Hyunwoo's 'character information'.

**<Character List>**

Name: Ye Hyunwoo (???)

Age: 17

Sponsor: None (currently, 7 constellations are showing interest in this person).

Exclusive attributes: Leader of the Silver Screen (Heroic), Marksman (Rare), Seeker (Rare), ▪▪▪▪▪ (???)

Exclusive Skills: [Weapon Improvement Lv.4], [Mental Barrier Lv.5], [Leadership Lv.3], [Horsepower Sharing Lv.5], [Lie Detection Lv.4].

Stigma: None.

Overall Ability: [Stamina Lv.35], [Strength Lv.30], [Agility Lv.28], [Magic Lv.40]

Some Constellations expressed displeasure at the strange airflow felt from him.

It was a list window that looked exactly like the characters, except for three question marks next to their names and some of their characteristics filtered out.

Perhaps the question mark next to the name is Ye Hyunwoo's real name, and the filtering of the characteristics is a characteristic related to 'reader'.

Just by looking at his overall ability and skill level, he could tell how hard Ye Hyunwoo had grown.

While I was genuinely delighted with the fact, I couldn't hide my slight concern.

Why did Ye Hyunwoo become a 'character' at this point?

No matter how much I think about it, I don't know.

If you think about it, the exact mechanism of 'characterization' has not been revealed in the end.

Lee Gilyoung and Yoo Sangah were also prominent figures 'outside the novel', but since the collection of information on the list of characters began much later than Lee Seongguk or Jung Minseop, I took a breath and called Ye Hyunwoo's name without expressing my emotions as much as possible.

"Hyunwoo-ssi."

"Yes?"

"Do you remember the contents of 'Omniscient Reader'?"

Ye Hyunwoo, who was staring at me, lowered his voice and asked.

"Are you talking about the Book of Revelation?"

"Ah, yes."

Come to think of it, the apostles called the novel that way.

"Of course I remember. You know how many times have I read it."

Without realizing it, my heart was beating fast.

“Inho-ssi? Your complexion is not very good..."

"Do you remember what our goal is?"

"Our goal? Seeing the end of this world, right?"

"And?"

"And..."

Why did I ask that?

I do not know.

However, I just wanted to check.

That even if he became a character, he is still the Ye Hyunwoo that I remember.

That he still remembers the story we had together and recognizes that this world is a novel.

I just wanted to check.

However.

"To be happy?"

I was dazed for a moment.

「This time, tell me a happy story.」

Suddenly, Kim Dokja's words came to mind. Ye Hyunwoo was laughing with an embarrassed face.

"Are you all right, Inho-ssi? Why are you suddenly asking such a thing?"

"Inho-ssi."

"Ah, yes."

Ye Hyunwoo reached out and grabbed my shoulder.

"You're in a strange condition. You seem to have a fever. You're breaking out in a cold sweat. Let's go into the tent for a while and talk."

I was dragged along as if being supported by Ye Hyunwoo and sat down on a chair provided in the tent.

"Eat this."

As I drank the warm leaf tea that Ye Hyunwoo gave me, I felt my breathing calm down a bit.

Anyway.

"How did you get this?"

"I acted a little cute to the constellations."

Ye Hyunwoo's grinning expression somehow resembled the Kim Dokja I remember. Does Ye Hyunwoo likes tea because he is also a fragment of Kim Dokja?

「What happened to the other fragments of Kim Dokja?」

I decided to get straight to the point.

"I would like to hear briefly about the current situation."

The reason I came to Gwanghwamun was because of Ye Hyunwoo's message.

'Failed to secure the sword.'

Considering the end of the fourth scenario, it is now necessary to secure the 'sword of death'.

What the hell happened that they didn't get the sword of death?

"First of all, I think I should inform you about the situation after Inho-ssi departure?"

When I nodded, Ye Hyunwoo briefly explained what had happened over the past few days.

It is said that right after I left, the Chungmuro Group started to expand its influence. Anyway, the battle for the flag must have begun. There was no reason to take any more time.

Clear minor sub-scenarios, capture the flags of other stations,

"In the process, Seonah noona and Kyungsik helped me a lot."

Goo Seonah and Kim Kyungsik. Incarnations who have read the whole novel 8 times and 6 times, respectively.

Once again, I realized the potential of the Chungmuro Group.

Considering the combination of Gong Pildoo and Ye Hyunwoo, Chungmuro was, in fact, a group with the strongest fighting power at the moment.

"What about Killer King and his sister?"

"They left the station right after Inho-ssi left."

Well, Killer King will only hang out with his younger sister like Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk must be on the move with Yoo Mia by now.

"After that, a war broke out with the neighboring stations, and I benefited from the 'Singijeon' that was given to me at that time."

Class A Replica Singijeon.

It seems that it was worthwhile to pass it on.

"Everything went smoothly until we ran into the coalition forces at Gwanghwamun Station."

"A union?"

"Yes. Allied forces, including the tyrant king, were waiting."

The Tyrant King was one of the most powerful kings in Omniscient Reader.

"No matter how good the Tyrant King is, it would be difficult to deal with the current leader and Hyunwoo-ssi."

I don't know if it's Gong Pildu or Ye Hyunwoo, but these two are a combination that more than doubles their synergy when they're together.

If Gong Pildu's [Armed Zone] and Ye Hyunwoo's [Magic Sharing] unite, there would be virtually no opponent to fear in the early stages except for Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Haa… Actually, I was thinking that too, but I was caught off guard."

To start with the conclusion, Ye Hyunwoo and Gong Pildu did not even have a proper fight with the Tyrant King.

"It was a mistake to divide the forces. Some of our main forces were ambushed inside the Palace Museum."

"So now the Palace Museum is…"

Before entering the tent, I saw the Palace Museum completely collapsed.

The building collapsed as if it had been bombed.

"Yes. That's right. Even if the entire building collapsed as an explosion occurred inside, it's impossible to enter the interior at all because of that."

There might be a way to blow up the building parts with Gong Pildu's turret and enter, but in that case, colleagues inside could get hurt.

Perhaps Ye Hyunwoo called me because of such a dilemma.

"The fact that he set a trap in the Palace Museum means he knows about the Death Sword."

"Yes, it seems that someone knows the information of the Book of Revelation."

I don't know if it's a reader or a member of the Misreading Association, but I understood the situation anyway.

"Who are the people who entered?"

"Seonah noona and Kyungsik..."

"Isn’t the old man able to get out?"

Reader Kim Kyungshik had the [Smoke Man] skill. [Smoke Man] is a skill that allows you to vaporize your body using smoke from a smoking pipe.

If it is unclear whether even Kim Kyungshik is alive or dead, then a serious problem must have occurred inside the building.

"We are also suffering from it. Originally, if something happened, Kyungshik Ahjussi was supposed to escape alone and inform me of the situation, but we lost contact..."

"Are there any other people inside?"

"There are a few other members of the group, but they are not very talented. And.."

Ye Hyunwoo hesitated a little before saying the last words, then added.

"Dansu-ssi also entered."

"Dansu Ahjussi?"

I asked in surprise.

Dansu Ahjussi must have followed Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon to Myeongdong Station.

"I saw him leaving with Lee Jihye too. They came here alone last night."

For a moment, I thought I knew what had happened, even though I hadn't heard anything.

If ahjussi gave up on the mission he was talking about and came back, there is only one reason.

"They said that Jiyoon is in that museum."

---

After completing my simple preparations, I stood at the entrance of the collapsed National Palace Museum.

"Inho-ssi. Are you really going to be okay by yourself?"

"I have to go alone anyway."

If it were me in the past, I would have entered with an escort.

But I couldn't bring an escort with me now. It was because I had to use a special item I had to enter that abandoned building.

"Change into the Ever-Changing Stealth Suit."

When I gave the command with [Incite], 'Thought' turned into translucent clothes that covered my entire body.

One of its features is to change your appearance you want.

['Ever-Changing Stealth Suit' is activated!]

My body shrunk in an instant, and it shrunk to about the size of a thumb, as if I had used miniaturization.

[The change limit has been reached.]

[You can’t get any smaller.]

Surprised, Ye Hyunwoo looked at me and exclaimed.

[The constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier says there is a problem with your item usage.]

It was fortunate that I got the 'Ever-Changing Stealth Suit' in the decisive battle with RepresentativeKimDokja. First of all, the goal is to go down among the piles of abandoned buildings and infiltrate the dungeon of the Palace Museum.

I was about to go right through the collapsed stones, but Ye Hyunwoo called me.

"Inho-ssi."

When I glanced around, Ye Hyunwoo was looking at me with a complicated face.

Somehow, I seemed to know what Ye Hyunwoo was going to say.

"Inho-ssi… Are you really a reader?"

He must have some idea of who I am now.

So I didn't lie this time. Whatever he meant by 'reader'.

"Yes, I'm not."

"You must come back."

I nodded and went straight into the abandoned building. I quickly ran through the empty space between the stones. Shortly after, a collapsed marble lobby appeared.

I looked at the dead bodies of people who had been stretched out among the collapsed rubble. There were often familiar faces, but there were no Dansu ahjussi or readers' faces.

I raised my head and looked ahead.

The lobby to enter the dungeon.

[A new hidden scenario has arrived!]

What I'm looking for lies deeper.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 645 Episode 18 Father (3)

**<Hidden Scenario - Relic of Trials>**

Category: Hidden

Difficulty: F~A+

Clear conditions: Clear the 'Relic Dungeon' for the right number of people.

Time limit: None.

Reward: 500~5,000 coins

Failure: Death

[Select the type of dungeon to enter.]

* 1-person dungeon - Field of Nagak

* 3-person dungeon - Acupuncturists' Field

* 5-person dungeon - Donguibogam

* 7-person dungeon - Yongjun's Jang

The group of three, including Kim Dokja, arrived here in the main part of the book, and they chose the '3-person dungeon', the 'Acupuncturists' Field'.

Anyway, since I was alone, I had no other options.

"I will choose the one-man dungeon, the Field of Nagak."

[You enter the 1-person dungeon.]

Little information was known about the Field of Nagak.

I checked the 'Ways of Survival' skill and the notes I had written, but nothing came to mind right away.

I can’t help it.

This time, I have to experience it for myself.

[You are the 5th to enter the single-person dungeon.]

At the same time as entering, the 'Ever-Changing Stealth Suit' was deactivated. Because from now on, there was no need to make my body smaller.

The Nagak's field was like a huge terrarium that someone artificially decorated.

The rocky land rose between the puddles that submerge people up to the chin.

Hermit crabs about 1 meter tall were also seen creeping and crawling over the land.

Those must be 'Nagaks'.

[If you defeat more than 100 'Nagak', you will be eligible to escape the dungeon.]

[Obtain 2 Sangpyeong Tongbo as a basic reward for every 100 Nagak hunts.]

In order to enter the 'Chapter of the Big Dipper' where the sword of death lies, you must collect 10 Sangpyeong Tongbo.

In other words, I have to catch at least 500 Nagaks.

As I moved slowly, the nagaks who felt my presence turned their antennae all at once.

[The 8th grade sea species 'Small Nagak' has noticed your presence!]

I still don't know the attack pattern of these guys.

However, I know what kind of instrument a 'Nagak' is. A brass instrument made from conch shells.

According to my guess, their attack method is-

[The Nagak Ensemble begins.]

Ugh, I feel like the air is boiling.

I instinctively looked left and right, then took about twenty steps to the left.

And after a while.

Woo woo woo woo.

There was a deafening roar as if dozens of herds of bison were vomiting at once. I could see the floor on which I had been standing until the moment it was turned into clay with a sound.

As expected, it was an attack using sound.

Fortunately, they did not continue. The monsters stopped crying all at once, probably sucking in their breath to make the sound again.

I started hunting them.

When I approached in an instant and took out 'Broken Faith', the surprised hermit crab tried to defend itself by sticking out a small claw crab.

[The 'Blade of Faith' is activated!]

However, there is no way that an ether blade can be blocked with only a 8th class sea monster's carapace.

While the Nagak, whose claw had been cut off, vomited a sound, I inserted a new sword into the gap in the Nagak.

[You have hunted 1 'Nagak'.]

After learning how to hunt one, it was easy.

Avoiding the 'Nagak ensemble' pouring out at regular intervals, I ran between the conch shells.

Every time I swing the Blade of Faith, one Nagak loses its life.

[You have hunted 23 'Nagaks'.]

[You have hunted 24 'Nagaks'.]

If I feel a little bit out of magic, I bought from the dokkaebi’s bag in advance.

I also used an intermediate magic recovery potion.

[You have hunted 152 'Nagaks'.]

[You have hunted 153 'Nagaks'.]

I didn’t forget to look around to see if there were other incarnations around me.

There weren’t.

Occasionally I could see gear or clothing dropped by people, but I couldn't find a living person.

It was definitely difficult for a single player dungeon.

Defeating hundreds of Nagak and obtaining a notification of the award must be a formidable task for ordinary incarnations.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' rejoices in your growth.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' says that he has caught on to his income.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' says he heard that the horn meat is good for hair loss and strengthening stamina.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband asks if that's true.]

The messages of the constellations came into my head.

After defeating the ark at Seoul Station, I felt that the number of constellations permanently residing in the channel increased.

Of course, not everyone in the neighborhood cheered me on, but...

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' complains that it is not fun because there is no crisis.]

In any case, it was around the time that the number of Nagaks I hunted exceeded 400.

[The constellation that has not revealed their modifier warns you that it is not going to be an easy dungeon.]

With a somewhat ominous message, a light vibration occurred throughout the terrarium.

[The number of slaughtered 'Nagak' in the 'Nagak's Field' has exceeded 400!]

[Someone is very angry at the Nagaks' death!]

[Higher seawater species appear!]

I saw something rise up in the huge puddle that occupied the center of the 'Nagaks' Field'.

It was a huge conch shell with a height the size of a small house.

[6th sea species, Ancient Nagak has awakened!]

It's not even 7th grade, it's suddenly 6th grade?

At this point, if it was a 6th sea species, it was not easy to deal for even Jung Heewon who has activated [Time of Judgment].

A tingling feeling of life was transmitted through the hair on my forearm.

Should I run away now?

[Penalty for high-ranking sea species is activated!]

[You cannot escape from the dungeon for the next 10 minutes.]

Unable to escape for 10 minutes.

In other words, if I manage to survive for 10 minutes, I can escape.

[A handful of constellations are now licking their lips saying that it will be a little fun.]

The ancient Nagak twisted its massive body, and before I knew it, his antennae was pointing toward me.

[6th sea species 'Ancient Nagak' has noticed your presence.]

I swallowed lightly and thought.

「To what extent can I fight now?」

Come to think of it, I wasn't that weak.

I got my first story just before the fourth scenario was over, and I raised my overall ability to the limit of the scenario.

There is no 'Unbreakable Faith', but there is 'Broken Faith' that can be infinitely regenerated with 'Thought', and I can use [white and blue steel]. The 'outer suit' obtained in the theater dungeon is still intact.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' says that the meat of the Ancient Nagak is in the limelight as a food to prevent hair loss.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' asks if it's real.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' bets his hair and says it's real.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' says that this 'Bald General of Justice'has never eaten Nagaks' meat.]

…

[A new bounty scenario has arrived!]

**<Bounty Scenario - Precious Hair>**

Classification: Sub

Difficulty: B+

Clear Condition: Hunt the Ancient Nagak and donate the Ancient Nagak to the Prisoner of the Golden Headband.

Time limit: 1 hour.

Reward: 2,000 coins, ???

Failure: —

I stared blankly at the newly appeared scenario window and suddenly came to my senses.

It was an unexpected opportunity.

Even a 'Bounty Scenario' directly imposed by the Prisoner of the Golden Headband.

If it was Kim Dokja, he would never have missed this opportunity.

After making a light call, I fixed my 'Broken Faith'.

Let's try it.

Because I already know how to attack Nagaks.

Without giving me more time, I ran towards the 'Ancient Nagak'. The plan was to activate the 'blade of faith' with maximum output immediately, and cut down its skin at once.

However.

Quadddeuk!

Surprisingly, the shell of the 6th grade Sea Species deflected the 'Blade of Faith'.

Strong enough to block the ether blade. The moment I took a few steps in my panic, I heard an ominous vibration.

The 'ensemble' of the ancient Nagak is about to begin.

I quickly stepped back and searched for a place out of reach of sound waves.

A cold sweat ran down my back.

I could feel it instinctively. The ensemble of the 'Ancient Nagak' had a different attack range than the other Nagaks.

I could see the Ancient Nagak tally swaying as if mocking me.

Whoa! Whoa! Whoa! Whoa! Whoa! Whoa! Whoa!

A huge circular sound wave was emitted from the Ancient Nagak as the center. I reflexively turned my back and ran away.

I had to run as far as possible, to a place where those sound waves couldn't reach.

Bubbeobuck!

But the sound was faster than my steps.

Even though I retreated to the point where the sound wave weakened, it felt like I was getting a concussion the moment I got hit. I felt sick to my stomach and felt nauseous. In the distance, I saw two Ancient Nagaks swaying.

[Exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' is activated!]

This time, Ways of Survival was activated just in time.

「"There’s an easy way to hunt ancient nagak."」

Those were the words of Yoo Joonghyuk, without a doubt, another sentence of 'Ways of Survival' came to mind next.

「"You can't avoid his ensemble attack even if you cover your ears."」

I already know. I just had my ears covered.

「"The attack method is simple."」

As expected, our regressor protagonist seemed to know the strategy of hunting an 'Ancient Nagak'.

「"Just before he opens his mouth for an ensemble."」

Before opening its mouth?

「"Run faster than the speed of sound and cut it in half with a powerful punch."」

Did I hear it wrong?

I rolled on the floor mindlessly avoiding the 'Nagak's Ensemble'.

「"There is an easier way."」

Fortunately, that was not the end of Yoo Joonghyuk's words.

「"All you have to do is hit its shell with the [Pacheonbuk Fist] that has reached its climax. No matter how hard the shell is, it can't handle the impact of the mesosphere."」

Yoo Joonghyuk's unlucky smile came to life before my eyes.

「"It's a basic strategy that anyone can do."」

I can understand why Kim Dokja hit Yoo Joonghyuk in the back of the head at every opportunity.

When I came to my senses, I was surrounded by miniature Nagaks.

There is no place to avoid the next attack.

In the distance, the second ensemble of 'Ancient Nagak' was about to begin.

What should i do?

Can I use the 'Shield of Hercules'? [Air Area Defense] works against sword attacks. Can I defend?

Or not-

"This way."

A human voice came from somewhere.

When I turned my head, a small hand was fidgeting between the shells of the 'Nagak' from a few steps away.

The owner of the hand raised the shell while walking, and poked her head out through a small gap.

"Here. Come in here."

The moment I checked the child's face, I felt like my heart stopped.

Why is this child here?

Yoo Joonghyuk’s voice echoed in my head.

「"Of course, I don’t bother to get my hands dirty hunting something like 'Nagaks'."」

In the distance, the ancient trumpets of horns resounded, and the wind blew the wavy hair of the child.

Brilliant light brown hair.

It was a child I knew well.

"Ahjussi."

The fifth member of <Kim Dokja’s Company> I met.

The first incarnation of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"Quickly. Come in!"

A child who will go through the most terrible things in this 41st turn.

An incarnation that finally becomes a disaster in another world line.

「"Take care of it, Beast Lord."」

Disaster of Floods—Shin Yoosung was there.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 646 Episode 18 Father (4)

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Why is Shin Yoosung in this dungeon now?

I put my rising doubts behind and moved my body as if sliding to enter the Nagak where Shin Yoosung was hiding.

Doo doo doo!

A sound like a rapid drumming rang out, and I felt the air pressure in my ears change. But other than that, there were no other hits. This shell prevented the ensemble attack of 'Ancient Nagak'.

"You won't get attacked if you're inside. I'm not sure why..."

It was a way I hadn't thought of.

Come to think of it, the Nagaks here would also listen to each other's ensemble, but they weren't hurting each other.

We held our breath as we lay on our stomachs inside the narrow shell. When the sound had quieted down a bit, I lifted the shell slightly and explored the surroundings.

In the distance, an Ancient Nagak could be seen pacing the terrarium.

Apparently, they hadn't found us yet.

"I feel safe now."

When the faint light came through the cracks in the shell, the face of Shin Yoosung, whom I had seen before, came into my eyes once again.

「It was a magical moment.」

Shin Yoosung stuttered in embarrassment at my gaze.

"Well, he was originally a child who had almost reached the end of his lifespan. By chance, he communicated with me, and he said he wanted to give me a house of his own..."

It was only belatedly that I realized that Shin Yoosung was talking about this shell.

There must have been a hermit crab in here too.

However, the guy seemed to have passed on this shell to Shin Yoosung.

It was something that could have happened to Shin Yoosung, not to anyone else.

Because she is an incarnation that can communicate with monsters.

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Shin Yoosung

Age: 11

Sponsor: None (currently, 1 constellation is showing interest).

Exclusive Traits: Beast Tamer (Rare), Reflective Murderer (Normal)

Exclusive Skill: [Tame Lv.5], [Multispecies Sympathy Lv.6], [Agile Feet Lv.5], [Heterogeneous Favor Lv.3].

Stigma: None.

Overall stats: [Strength Lv.15], [Stamina Lv.12], [Agility Lv.18], [Magic Power Lv.27]

> Overall evaluation: This incarnation has decent Magic Power, but overall stats are low. She has outstanding talent and rare traits, but has not bloomed due to environmental reasons.

I recalled the contents of the main story while reading and compared the abilities of Shin Yoosung in front of me with the main story.

I don't know what the difference is, but some skills and overall stat levels were a little different from what I knew.

The question I had been thinking of for a while popped into my mind once again.

Why is Shin Yoosung here?

According to my memory, Shin Yoosung became a wanderer for a long time, and it was after the 'fourth scenario' that she met Kim Dokja.

I sincerely bowed my head.

"Thank you for saving me."

"Ah, yes..... no!"

In any case, if it weren't for this child, I would have fallen prey to the 'Ancient Nagak' without moving here.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' admires the actions of this incarnation.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is moved by the good deeds of incarnation 'Shin Yoosung'.]

A message from the constellations flying in the air.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' sponsors 100 coins to incarnation 'Shin Yoosung'.]

"Ah. Ah..."

Shin Yoosung, who received a sponsorship, looked back at me with a confused expression. I nodded my head as a sign to accept it quickly. Shin Yoosung, blushing, bowed her head to the air.

"Thank you. Thank you."

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is impressed by the incarnation.]

[An anonymous constellation says that these are all tricks to extract coins.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' laments that the constellations have lost their innocence these days.]

I felt strange.

Was this Shin Yoosung before meeting Kim Dokja?

I opened my mouth in a low voice so as not to be noticed by other monsters.

"I'm late to introduce myself. My name is Cheon Inho."

"I'm... Shin Yoosung."

Shin Yoosung said that and added hesitantly.

"You're an adult, so you can talk comfortably."

"No. You are my benefactor."

Shin Yoosung opened her eyes wide and rolled only her pupils.

"But I feel like I'm doing something wrong because I'm being treated with respect by an adult…"

Apparently, Shin Yoosung felt uncomfortable hearing respectful words from adults.

After hesitating for a moment, I replied:

"You don't know what type of person I am yet."

"A little... I know."

You know?

Shin Yoosung wriggled her hands for a moment as if she was embarrassed, then pointed to my coat pocket and said,

"You took care of the belongings of the dead."

When did you come to that conclusion?

In fact, I took the belongings of the dead incarnations while hunting Nagaks.

It was to check if there were any incarnations I knew, including Dansu ahjussi, and to inform the people of the Chungmuro group if there were any faces they knew.

"You're going outside to let others know... right?"

Those who entered the one-man dungeon, 'Nagak's Field', were more likely to be in a relatively isolated position in the group.

If there was a party, of course they would have entered a 3-person, 5-person, or 7-person dungeon.

Choosing one person must mean that there was a reason why they had no choice but to come in alone.

"I just packed the items. Why did you come in alone, Yoosoung-ssi?"

"Oh, I am..."

When our eyes met, Shin Yoosung hurriedly lowered her head and stammered.

"Because grown-ups don’t like teaming up with me…"

I knew it.

In a word, everything made sense.

The reason Shin Yoosung was here alone, and the reason why she was hiding and observing my actions...

"They are bad adults."

"Ah, no. But he said that if I clear this place and get a 'commentary notice', he will go with me. He said he would accept me into the group."

Did they even ask a child who hadn't even joined the group to do that?

"They are really bad adults."

"Oh, oh, not really. It's a natural choice for them."

"A natural choice?"

"Someone said that adults and children are equal in this world. Now, children are not children… But things like me aren't very helpful… Rather, giving me an opportunity like this… I should be thankful..."

I was extremely confused.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' lights a double wick in her eyes.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' laments that the virtues of the Korean Peninsula have fallen to the ground.]

As Kim Dokja once said, in an apocalyptic world, there was not much difference between children and adults.

Children can also become stronger by raising their abilities with coins.

Therefore, Shin Yoosung, a child, could say things like that as if she understood the circumstances of the adults.

But is it really okay?

Just because a new world has begun, is it okay to suddenly leave such a burden on the children?

Is it okay to treat children and adults as completely equal just because they have the same physical abilities?

"Which group of people said that?"

Children in this world are scary.

Like the children of the Beggar Sect, there are even children who specialize in hunting adults.

So, while asking that question, I didn't miss the possibility that it was Shin Yoosung's acting.

Even when she actually met Kim Dokja, Shin Yoosung was a child who could use the sympathy of adults.

But if all this was this little kid's design, it was fine as it was.

Knowing a child's desires but turning a blind eye to them.

Because that might be the only gift you can give a child as an adult living in this crazy world.

"That... I can't remember their name... It's a group that belongs to a place called the Union."

Union.

It was a name I had heard from Ye Hyunwoo.

Did you say it was a group of kings, including the tyrant king?

"Let's escape from here together."

We have to somehow get Shin Yoosung out of here.

And, unlike the main story, I must see the faces of the proud adults who drove the child to death with my own eyes.

[You have hunted 504 Nagaks.]

[Dungeon escape will be possible after 1 minute.]

The time to escape was drawing near.

I had finished hunting 500 Nagaks, which was my target, so all I had to do was wait. However, Shin Yoosung muttered weakly.

"I can't go. I haven't met my quota yet."

Well, it's a dungeon that even adults couldn't clear. Even if she was talented, there was no way Shin Yoosung, who was only a child, couldn’t clear it alone.

"I'll help you."

If you hunt only 100 Nagaks, you can meet the escape condition of the 'Nagak’s Field'.

The problem is that the Ancient Nagak is looking for us from afar.

But while I'm wasting my time, if Shin Yoosung just hunts Nagaks one by one-

[The character 'Shin Yoosung' feels extreme mental pain.]

Watching Shin Yoosung tremble with her arms wrapped around her, I realized that I was one step closer to the Shin Yoosung Kim Dokja met.

"I'm sorry. I can't."

Shin Yoosung's first scenario flashed through my mind.

She is a child who had to survive by killing her dog.

Shin Yoosung's trauma was still vivid.

"I'm sorry. You can go alone. I can stay here, so-"

I thought it didn't matter whether it was acting or not.

If that's acting.

[Some constellations are curious about your next choice.]

That's what's wrong is this world that made Shin Yoosung act like that.

"I'll die if I'm here alone."

"You don't want to die. You don't have to say that."

Shin Yoosung still hung her head.

"The school teaches you what to do in dangerous situations."

However, not everyone can do what they are taught at school.

Everyone knows that you should be considerate of the elderly and that you shouldn't hurt people.

I know that when I need help, I have to tell someone to help me.

But some people can't tell even if they know it.

There are people who have become like that.

"Shin Yoosung helped me even though I didn't ask for help. So, I will help you too."

It's not because I'm an adult. It's not because Shin Yoosung is a child.

I’m just helping, because she's the one I can help right now.

Shin Yoosung, still unable to meet my eyes, opened her mouth.

"But I don't have the confidence to kill the monsters..."

"Killing is not the only answer."

I checked the number of monsters scattered throughout the terrarium.

Is it because I slaughtered quite a few of them?

Now, there were not that many living monsters in this 'Field of Nagak'.

There is no sign that Nagak's numbers are increasing.

If so, there is one way to try it out.

"You don't have to kill them. Instead, it can be a little painful."

However, in order to use this method, Shin Yoosung’s help was needed.

"Maybe it's harder than killing. It's hard on the body, not the mind."

"If that's the case."

Shin Yoosung raised her head and looked up at me.

"I'd like to. If I don't have to kill anything."

She is a determined child.

I nodded and said.

"Then let's try it."

"By the way, are you okay? If you're in trouble because of me—"

"No problem. And don't worry too much."

I smiled lightly as if to calm a frightened child.

"No matter what happens, I will protect you."

I briefly explained the operation.

Shin Yoosung, who has a good brain, understood my words right away.

"Can I really do that?"

"It will be."

This operation relied entirely on Shin Yoosung's talent.

Shin Yoosung must believe in me to make this method possible.

"Start."

I flipped the cudgel cover and started running.

I must have walked dozens of steps after stepping on a puddle, and the monsters around me, noticing my presence, all looked at me in unison.

[Nagak ensemble begins.]

The sound waves inadvertently pouring behind my steps.

I gave a signal to Shin Yoosung, who was looking at me from a distance, while running.

[The character, 'Shin Yoosung' activates 'Tame Lv.5'!]

[The character 'Shin Yoosung' activates 'Multispecies Sympathy Lv.6'!]

The purpose of this operation was simple.

While I was attracting the attention of the Nagaks, Shin Yoosung, who activated [Tame], tamed the Nagaks in the terrarium.

This operation was conceived from Shin Yoosung's status window.

[The character 'Shin Yoosung' is currently hunting 1 Nagak.]

Clearly, Shin Yoosung was in a state where she couldn't kill even a single Nagak. Nevertheless, Shin Yoosung already has a record of killing a Nagak. From this record, I can infer two hypotheses.

One, Shin Yoosung can actually kill Nagaks.

Two, simply 'taming' them is recognized as hunting.

Whichever hypothesis is correct, the operation was well worth a try.

Even if this operation fails-

「"I will send Shin Yoosung. It's an opportunity to increase her monster army."」

At the very least, Shin Yoosung will be able to secure monsters to protect herself from adults.

[Character 'Shin Yoosung' failed to 'tame'!]

The problem is that 'Shin Yuseung''s skill proficiency is too low.

From a distance, I could see Shin Yoosung's face stained with faint despair.

"Oh, Ahjussi—"

I cried out in a loud voice.

"Calm down, try again one by one! You can do it!"

In fact, it was difficult for Shin Yoosung at this point.

Even in the main story, Shin Yoosung tamed sea creatures of 7th or higher after growing up under the special training of Kim Dokja.

And unfortunately, there was no Kim Dokja in this world.

But.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.9' is activated!]

Shin Yoosung now has me.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 647 Episode 18 Father (5)

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「"You're useless."」

A sentence came into my mind.

「"If I take you with me, isn't it just a food bug?"」

「"Let’s send you to the dungeon. If you survive and come back, we’ll accept you in the group."」

I don't know if this is a sentence from 'Ways of Survival' or the voice that comes from within Shin Yoosung. What is certain is that Shin Yoosung, who is shouting from afar, is gradually losing her confidence.

"Don't listen to other people!"

No matter what I do now, I cannot change the history that has already been written for that child.

Even if I delete a sentence that has already been read once, it will not be deleted.

What I can do is to write the next sentence that the child will read darker and clearer.

[The attribute effect activates!]

And in that case, I was more confident than anyone else.

"You can do whatever you want! You don't have to kill monsters! If you think you can be friends, believe it!"

This world will not be as easy as the sentence I wrote.

There are monsters you can't be friends with, and monsters you can't tame.

Even a monster whose goal is to destroy this world like the 'last dragon of the Apocalypse'.

But.

"It's okay to fail!"

What was in front of Shin Yoosung now were 'Nagaks'.

Just because the cruel truth of the world exists in a faraway place, there is no need to trample even the smallest hope in front of you.

Nagaks can be tamed.

Shin Yoosung can do it.

"I'll buy you time, so try slowly again and again!"

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.9' is strongly activated!]

A whopping level 9 [Incite].

After obtaining the first story, my [Incite] became much stronger than before.

[The person's talent is temporarily enhanced by 'Strong Incite'.]

I tried to help Shin Yoosung [Tame] with my support. How much time passed?

A thread made of light flowed from Shin Yoosung's fingertips, and was soon connected to a Nagak.

[Character 'Shin Yoosung' succeeded in taming a 'Nagak'!]

As if she couldn't believe what she had done, Shin Yoosung widened her eyes.

"Good job! Continue!"

Shin Yoosung, who exchanged glances with me, nodded her head with a slightly confident face.

I avoided the Nagak's ensemble attack, and when I thought there was no place to escape, I hid myself using Nagak's shell.

Doo doo doo!

This attack was also easy to avoid because I memorized the pattern.

As Kim Dokja said, there is a breaking law in every scenario.

[Character 'Shin Yoosung' succeeded in taming a 'Nagak'!]

[Character 'Shin Yoosung' succeeded in taming a 'Nagak'!]

In the meantime, Shin Yoosung was steadily taming Nagaks.

I was just dragging time like this.

But there was one problem.

[The 6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' shows strange movements.]

The 'Ancient Nagak' was watching Shin Yoosung repeat [taming].

"Hide!"

Surprised, Shin Yoosung quickly dived into the shell of the Nagak without breathing.

Subsequently, the ensemble attack of the 'Ancient Nagak' swept near the Nagak where Shin Yoosung was hiding.

[6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' is indignant!]

After staying in the puddle all the way, he moved a heavy note for the first time. The claws caught on its long legs rolled across the terrarium floor.

It moved its long, tall legs to crush the dead bodies of Nagak one by one.

Kwajik!

Even without the ensemble, the Ancient Nagak’s physical ability was quite threatening.

I guess so.

If it's 6th-grade sea species, it's a monster on the same level as the 'Titano' that Lee Gilyoung tamed.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' makes a sad face.]

I lightly loosened my wrists and activated the [White and Blue Steel].

['Blade of Faith' is activated!]

With a gigiing sound, a blue blade rose from the Broken Faith.

I couldn't break its shell with the 'Blade of Faith' made with my magical power.

But what about its legs?

I ran toward it in a straight line and immediately swung the 'Blade of Faith'.

[Story 'The tenacious Murim master' speaks hesitantly]

The historical level story received from the ark.

Subsequently, the Ark's [Bong method] came into my mind, and the familiar movement of the Ark entered my fingertips in a story.

The strangely sluggish and awkward movements changed to those of a top-notch master the moment the story

Sugak!

The blow didn't cut it off, but the Ancient Nagak’s leg was cut in half.

It stumbled and screamed in pain.

I realized how amazing the skills of the Murim people are.

Humans who polished a single skill again and again.

I suddenly became curious.

The people stronger than the ark, what kind of training did the pajeon swordsman and Kyrgios go through to reach such a level? What kind of scenery is the world they see?

「I want to see and write all those stories.」

I swung my sword again. One of its legs was completely cut off and it rolled on the floor.

I was awakened by the sound, resounding like a bloody spirit. When the sea species mouth was released, I was already covered in the blood of a marine species.

[6th-grade marine species prepares for the Ancient Nagak's 'single ensemble'!]

The guy who sucked in his breath in an instant prepared to emit sound waves.

Almost reflexively, I fell on my stomach, covering myself with the shells around me.

But why?

I couldn't hear its ensemble.

Moments later, a hole opened through the top of the shell with a sound like a crushing sound. The antennae of the guy, visible through the broken back, were hoarding at me as if mocking me.

[The 6th-grade sea species, the Ancient Nagak, starts this short ensemble!]

It was too late to avoid it.

The shell no longer served as a protective film.

It had been aiming only for this moment all along.

"Ahjussi!"

I saw Shin Yoosung screaming at me from afar.

Nagak's grass flute was raised and spread.

「I'm going to die.」

If I die now.

「Shin Yoosung will also die.」

It can't be like that.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.9' is activated!]

"I am a 'Nagak'."

Perhaps it was momentarily confused by my [Incite]. However, some of the sound waves apparently flowed through the cracks in the shell and crashed into my eardrums.

My head spun around with a gigiing sound.

I was bleeding from my ear, but fortunately it was an internal injury that I could deal with.

"It's okay! Go ahead!"

Shin Yoosung confirmed my state and nodded her head with a relieved expression.

[Character 'Shin Yoosung' succeeded in taming a 'Nagak'!]

Perhaps because of the influence of [Incite], the Ancient Nagak was confused about whether I was a human or a Nagak.

But soon, as if it didn't matter, it came back to swing its claws toward me.

I dodged its claws and rolled across the floor.

After playing the ensemble in succession, the guy's music skills became a little sluggish.

I swung the sword once again without letting go of that gap.

Sgarack.

One more leg was cut off. At this rate, there would be no sudden attack. Instead, the guy's anger was now completely on me.

Kunauuu.

The tropical air was drawn into the ancient Nagak's mouth.

After a while, the ensemble will begin again.

['Broken Faith' disappears.]

[The 'thought of almost everything' refuses to imitate.]

Finally, the imitation time limit was over.

It was possible to regenerate it by using [Incite] again, but the problem was that it was difficult to maintain the 'Blade of Faith'.

I looked back at Shin Yoosung repeating [taming] from a distance.

「Eventually, she will become the Disaster of Floods.」

Even if I save Shin Yoosung here, she will cross over to another world line and become the Disaster of Floods.

I know.

That is the fate of this 41st turn.

「In a universe that was born of tragedy from the beginning, it would have been better if it did not exist.」

Kim Dokja's words echoed in my head.

I changed the 'thought' to a magic recovery bracelet and wore it on my wrist.

[Magic recovery bracelet's magic regeneration ability increases.]

I looked up at the Ancient Nagak.

Kim Dokja promised. He promised to watch my story. He told me to do what I want.

[The 6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' is preparing for a 'wide ensemble'!]

So I'll tell you what I want.

Even if the end of this world is destruction, even if it's an operation that I can't change.

Feeling the air around me thinning, I clenched my fists as if clenching the sides.

[The exclusive skill '□□' is activated!]

[Due to the probability restrictions of <Star Stream>, the skill cannot be activated.]

In the process of obtaining my first story, I lost a skill.

I heard the message a while ago, so it wasn't something I didn't know at all.

[This skill cannot be activated with your current skill.]

It was bittersweet for me, who had passed through countless crises thanks to '□□'. Being unable to use that skill was as if I wasn't qualified as the author of this story yet.

But then.

[Some of '□□''s functions are converted to sub-skills.]

[The sub-skill 'Sentence Enhancement' is activated!]

Sentence reinforcement?

「Cheon Inho is □□...□□.」

The moment I saw the sentence inside the message window, I had a sense of what kind of skill this was.

[You can enter your actions.]

[The action you enter is 'reinforced'.]

[The current enhancement level is level 1.]

[You can increase the level of reinforcement by injecting stocked probability.]

[Currently possessed probability: 515.]

Simply put, it felt like a simplified version of '□□'.

I tried writing a sentence to test it.

「Cheon Inho used 'Incite'.」

For a moment, I felt someone staring at me from behind my head. Immediately, vitality surged through my whole body. Someone who seemed to be able to do anything was born. To be precise.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite' is enhanced!]

I felt like I could [incite] anything now.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite' is temporarily awakened.]

[You can incite yourself to steal the person you want.]

Is that even possible?

[Instigating yourself as a different person has a chance to imitate that person's skill or surname.]

[However, if you incite yourself as a person of a higher rank than you, you will fail with a high probability and receive a penalty.]

[The recurrence rate of Incite increases according to your level of understanding of that person.]

I was surprised.

[Incite so far was a kind of self-suggestion skill.]

It's a little different when I'm in the 'snowfield', but in reality, I can only copy the character's behavior, tone, and personality.

However, according to the description of the skill now, through this [Incite], I will be able to really use that character's power.

Without waiting any longer, I activated [Incite].

A person who can overcome this crisis without difficulty. A person who could have escaped this dungeon without killing the Nagaks.

I thought while watching Shin Yoosung repeat [taming] from a distance.

[I'm Shin Yoosung, the 'Disaster of Floods'.]

Tsutsutsutchut.

I could tell without even trying.

This [Incite] is impossible.

In other words, it meant that 'Shin Yoosung, the Disaster of Floods', was a much higher-ranking being than I am now.

Still, I thought it would be worth a try since I got two stories.

[6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' starts wide-area ensemble!]

I couldn't take the risk here. If I don't succeed, Shin Yoosung will die.

This time, I have to overcome the crisis by [Inciting] myself as an existence of a lower rank than me.

The Ancient Nagak, who took all his breath, started playing an ensemble toward me.

I thought as I hid myself in the shells around me.

Shin Yoosung, the Disaster of Floods, failed. However, what if Shin Yoosung is from a different time period?

For example, if it were Shin Yoosung, who was of a lower rank than me. The pages of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' began to turn over clearly in my head.

「"Ahjussi! Don't go! Please! Don't go!"」

Shin Yoosung was chasing after Kim Dokja, who had become an Outer God.

「"The person I like has also appeared like this."」

Shin Yoosung, who participated in 'Journey to the West', the grand story of the <Emperor>.

「"Uh, uh. So... I'm grateful... for receiving this award..."」

Shin Yoosung, who participated in the 'War of Good and Evil', was talking about her acceptance speech to Kim Dokja.

「"...Ahjussi."」

Shin Yoosung, who was the first to recognize Kim Dokja, who became a giant squid.

The emotions rushing along with the sentences made my head feel like it would explode for a moment.

I went against it and traced the history of Shin Yoosung.

「"Ahjussi."」

The voice of Shin Yoosung calling Kim Dokja over and over again.

Is it because of the Ancient Nagak's sound?

Even though I knew it wasn't me she was calling, strangely my heart beat.

I read and re-read a story I once wrote.

「"Ahjussi, but this… can only be used against monsters?"」

And finally.

「"Shin Yoosung, whose eye color has slowly returned, was looking at me."」

The horn shell was crushed by the front legs of the 'Ancient Nagak', and the sound of the ensemble rushed in.

At the same time, I felt that my frequent sentences were nesting in me.

"I am—"

「As if it was nothing, the guy who had a nosebleed said.」

"I am the 'Shin Yoosung' who tamed 'Queen Mirabad'."

「"Let's go, Ahjussi."」

[The effect of 'Incite' activates!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 648 Episode 18 Father (6)

In the <Star Stream>, everything exists as a story.

[Incite was a skill that imitated the shell of such a story.]

What kind of tone he uses, what actions he does, and what kind of expressions he makes.

A skill that deceives the incarnations by copying the shell, and even deceives the <Star Stream>.

However, this skill ultimately failed to follow the essence of the story.

[The skill is linked with your memory.]

However, the awakened [Incite] made that impossible possible to some extent.

The skill I'm using now was proof of that.

[The exclusive skill 'Tame Lv.9' is activated!]

「Following the path of the aura that extended to Queen Mirabad, Shin Yoosung completely approached the body of the queen.」

Reading the story of someone's life, internalizing the story, and calling myself 'that person' with [Incite].

In other words, it was close to a kind of [stage painting] with my body as the background.

The sentences Shin Yoosung endured flowed through my head in real time, and I was living the scene once again.

「The Queen looked at Shin Yoosung, and Shin Yoosung looked at her fist.」

The difference is that it is not 'Shin Yoosung' and 'Queen Mirabad' who are reproducing the story now, but 'I' and the 'Ancient Nagak'.

Blood poured from my nose with the feeling of a push shot.

This was the feeling of connecting with the monster. The sense [taming] that Shin Yoosung always repeated.

Oh oh oh.

The Ancient Nagak resisted by waving its legs randomly, and I did not let go of the bond of sympathy while avoiding its attack.

[Exclusive skill 'Advanced Multispecies Sympathy Lv.3' is activated!]

「Stopstopstopstopstop」

It felt like one mind had differentiated into two bodies.

At that moment, I was the Ancient Nagak, and the Ancient Nagak was me.

My heart that wants to tame the Ancient Nagak and the Ancient Nagak that fears me.

Two hearts were coexisting.

Like when I heard the language of the puppies one day, countless sentences rushed into my head.

「Aaaaaaaaaaaaaaa!」

Words that are more like screams.

「Dokkaebiscarydokkaebiscarydokkaebiscary」

It was only then that the expression on the boy's face, which I could hardly read, caught my eye.

I've always thought he was laughing at me or being dangerous.

「Do not come」

But he was afraid of me. Not exactly me, but Shin Yoosung.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is curious about the taste of 'Raw Horn Meat'.]

6th-grade monsters are scary to early incarnations. However, from the point of view of the constellations, incarnations and 6th-grade monsters were the same bugs.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' says that when he was born, it was easy to have about 100 horns.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' says that there was no 'Field of Nagaks' at that time.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' makes fun of the conversation between the stars.]

A constellation is, after all, a constellation.

They are here to see the story. I and the Ancient Nagak had to spend our lives for them to survive.

We were the same.

「Don'tcomedon'tcomedon'tcome」

It seemed that it would finally understand.

[Exclusive skill, 'Taming Lv.9' is activated!]

Blood came out of my nose once again. My head felt like it would explode from the intense fear felt by the monster, and my breathing became rougher and rougher.

Shin Yoosung has continued [taming] in this compulsory sympathy hell every time.

By listening to them, understanding them, and finally becoming them in order to tame beings different from herself.

「Beast Lord, Shin Yoosung.」

The only thing that can understand a monster is the same monster.

Even though she was a child, Shin Yoosung understands monsters better than anyone else.

Perhaps it was only natural that she recognized Kim Dokja, who had become a disaster, before anyone else.

"Don't worry."

As if imitating Shin Yoosung, I spoke to the Ancient Nagak.

"Because it won't work."

No matter how much I [incited] myself to be Shin Yoosung who tamed Queen Mirabad, I don't expect that I will be able to tame the Ancient Nagak.

[The character 'Shin Yoosung' has succeeded in taming a 'Nagak'!]

[The character 'Shin Yoosung' has succeeded in taming a 'Nagak'!]

All I want is to buy a little more time and have Shin Yoosung tame 100 Nagaks.

So, to escape this dungeon together.

[Taming failed.]

['Advanced Multiplespecies Sympathy' is preserved.]

He didn't easily tame me, and I didn't tame him either.

But that's how we confronted each other.

Neither friend nor foe.

[The 6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' is glaring at you.]

Because this confrontation is the only way to endure this moment without hurting each other.

How many minutes had we stared at each other like that?

[The 6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' does not show hostility towards you.]

For the first time, a change occurred in our tense relationship.

[The 6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' is curious about you.]

Did he feel relief from my attitude? The lumbering guy's dwelling landed on the floor as if he had lost his will to fight. I could feel the air in preparation for the ensemble escaping from his body.

In an instant, a small glimmer of hope rose up.

Maybe it's possible?

[Your magic power is running low.]

But my mana was running out. It would have been a little better if I had consumed a magic recovery potion, but it was not possible.

I just had a hard time maintaining this [Incite] state.

「What Ahjussi is doing right now.」

At some point, the sentences that came to my mind changed.

「Should we think about it?」

Shin Yoosung's height, weight, what she likes, what she wants to eat, and what she dislikes, hobbies or specialties, favorite cartoon, favorite novel, person she likes, what she thinks when she looks at a person.

The more the [Incite] continued, the more I felt like I was being eaten up little by little by the value of that information.

Tsutsutsutsut.

Eventually, my magical power disappeared, [Tame] and [Advanced Communication] were canceled at the same time. On the other hand, [Incite] was still unresolved.

「Ahjussi.」

I couldn't stop thinking about something else.

This [Incite] was not a skill I could handle.

The Ancient Nagak, whose sympathy had been released, was approaching in front of me.

「You know.」

Is this the inside of Shin Yoosung?

「I really want to see you.」

Or is it an unwritten story?

「But.」

What happened to Shin Yoosung?

Is [taming] over?

Can we escape?

「I really hate you.」

Shin Yoosung.

「I really, really hate you.」

I.

[6th-grade sea species Ancient Nagak prepares for a 'wide-area ensemble'!]

I thought I should stop it, but my voice won't come out.

My body doesn't listen.

My thoughts do not flow normally.

My body, unable to overcome the Incite, was collapsing.

I thought someone was approaching me, but I heard a voice.

"Ahjussi, I did it. I tamed them all."

I turned to where the voice came from and asked.

"Who…"

There stood a child with a smile.

"Me? Shin Yoosung!"

"Shin Yoosung... Me?"

The child tilted her head.

[A side effect of Excessive Incite has occurred!]

"…Ahjussi?"

The child looked at me for a long time, then she smiled faintly.

[6th-grade sea species 'Ancient Nagak' starts 'wide ensemble'.]

"Ah. You tried to tame him."

The child said, "Hey," and she snorted, then stretched out her hand toward the Ancient Nargak with the back of my hand clasped.

"But that's not how you do it."

A thread of dim light stretched out from the child's fingertips, and was soon connected with the Ancient Nagak.

I stared blankly at the scenery. I couldn't figure out what was going on.

[The character 'Shin Yoosung' has tamed the Ancient Nagak!]

[There are no Nagaks left in the 'Field of Nagak'.]

[After a while, the dungeon will be forcibly closed.]

[After a while, all personnel will be banished to the lobby.]

How did she do it?

I couldn't believe it.

What I couldn't do, how can you do it so simply?

I'm sure she was a kid who had a hard time taming 'Nagaks' until a little while ago.

My mouth moved on its own.

"Shin... Yoosoung..."

The child happily nodded her head.

"Yes! It's me."

"You are...Shin Yoosung."

"Are you Ahjussi?"

Shin Yoosung tilted her head once again, then gave a small smile. Then she reached out her hands and cupped my cheeks, and she began to slap me from both sides.

"No! I'm Shin Yoosung! Take care of yourself!"

[The influence of Incite gradually weakens.]

I blankly looked down at the child and asked.

"Then... who am I...?"

Who I was.

Surely, it must have been something, but why can't I remember it?

I am.

"Who is your ahjussi?

The child held my cheeks tightly with both hands. The child's eyes were shining gold.

The child who slowly brought her lips to my ear whispered in a disturbing voice.

"My ahjussi is Kim Dokja."

['Incite' is canceled.]

I lost consciousness.

"You still faint every day, ahjussi."

Shin Yoosung laid Cheon Inho neatly on the floor and gently brushed his ragged hair.

"But why do you have to be Cheon Inho?"

Shin Yoosung took a look at Cheon Inho's face and then licked her lips.

"Is it because of ahjussi's body? I think he's a bit handsome."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is glaring at you.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' asks when did you possess it.]

"I hear an insect crying somewhere."

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is indignant!]

[The constellation ' Sneaky Schemer' says this is unfair!]

Shin Yoosung smiled.

—Then, do you want to be a character too?

[The constellation, 'Sneaky Schemer' says he can't go because he doesn't have someone to possess.]

"It is very noisy. Don't these dokkaebis manage the channel?"

When the child lightly looked up into the air, to her surprise, there was a faint spark.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' is complaining that the screen transmission has been cut off from a while ago!]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' says he thought only he was broken!]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' threatens to request a refund from the administration if this continues.]

[The management bureau is checking the local channels.]

While noisy messages were scattered all over the place, Shin Yoosung looked quietly at the fallen Cheon Inho.

Cheon Inho's face looked very tired.

Cheon Inho was even talking in his sleep, as if he was having a bad dream.

After hesitating for a moment, Shin Yoosung put her ear closer.

"Please help me, Yoo Joonghyuk-nim."

Shin Yoosung's expression darkened.

"Is this Yoo Joonghyuk-nim a bit violent?"

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says he is violent anywhere.]

Shin Yoosung looked down at Cheon Inho, who was talking in his sleep, and wore a bitter smile.

"It looks like a lot has happened."

There will be many incidents with him in the future.

Events that are more impressive than the stories he accumulated together may fill his life.

Shin Yoosung felt that way and she hated herself.

"Ahjussi."

There are many things she wants to ask.

But she also knew that she couldn't get an answer.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' says that this man is not the Kim Dokja we know.]

Shin Yoosung nodded her head.

"I know, I know."

Shin Yoosung always thought of him when she watched the sky, and imagined dreams when he dreamed.

"This person is also ahjussi."

The two children looked at the fallen Cheon Inho for a long time.

At that time, something sparkling flowed from the Ancient Nagak towards Cheon Inho's body.

[A new 'Failure' is recorded.]

Something very faint and insignificant, but still shining softly.

Shin Yoosung realized what it was.

"What?"

Clearly, it was a story. Shin Yoosung, her eyes wide open, looked down at Cheon Inho.

"The reason ahjussi came to this world…"

「'Failure' is recorded on the 'last wall'.」

Shin Yoosung's expression froze.

Something was watching them. A solemn and distant wall on which everything in this world was recorded looked down on them.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' growls.]

As if to protect her, Lee Gilyoung stepped forward. The world spoke to them.

「This is not a place assigned to you.」

The dungeon collapsed, and everything faded into the light.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 649 Episode 19 People of the Past (1)

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rlaehrmk37: These days, I like old stories.

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Tsutsutsu. Shin Yoosung suddenly opened her eyes.

The last thing she saw was the scenery of the dungeon scattered in the light.

Her heart sank.

Maybe something is wrong.

How is ahjussi?

She blinked several times, but all she could see was darkness.

[Connection Lost]

Shin Yoosung exhaled lightly and reached out her hand to take off her goggles.

Then, she saw a pure white circular device and patients rotating violently around the device.

[Part 41: The connection error is being corrected.]

[Searching for a new access point.]

"Hey! It bounced because of you!"

Looking around, Lee Gilyoung was annoyed and took off his connection. Shin Yoosung narrowed her eyes and said:

"What nonsense. It must be because of you."

"It bounced because you used your abilities excessively. Sooyoung-noona told you not to use skills recklessly in the 41st round! No, and why did you log in together!"

Shin Yoosung shrugged her shoulders, refusing to listen to him.

"Who was the one who recklessly send indirect messages? Isn't that what caused the probability error?"

"That—"

"But you're good at making that formula? Are you a Sneaky Schemer?"

Lee Gilyoung, his face reddened, screamed.

"Call Seolhwa noona quickly. I need to fix this!"

"You do it. I could have talked to him more, but you turned me down."

"Didn't he say he wasn't Dokja-ssi?"

"You are right, Dokja-ssi. Dokja-ssi was reincarnated."

"Hyung doesn't have any memories, but what?"

How many minutes had they been bickering like that? Lee Seolhwa's voice flowed from the speaker installed on the top of the connected device.

—Did you break it again? I'll fix it, so stop fighting. Go out and take a look outside for a while.

To the voice that came from the air, the two children answered "Yes".

—And I definitely told you not to connect at the same time, right? The device is still incomplete, so if you connect at the same time…

The two children rushed out of the room. Lee Gilyoung asked while walking down the long corridor.

"Where is Sangah-ssi?"

"Room 3. She’s still online."

Yoo Sangah could be seen through the glass of the door with the number 3 written on it.

Yoo Sangha was wearing goggles sitting in front of her device, the same one they connected to.

Her eyes were obscured, so they couldn't get a good look at her face, but with her lips she seemed to be saying something intently.

Shin Yoosung said in a worried voice.

"You have to eat."

She pays for it, and she has already been online for thirty-six hours. On the screen that floated in front of her, the screen she was looking at was reflected.

A view of Gwanghwamun in ruins. The National Palace Museum of Korea collapsed. Lobby engulfed in flames. Among the incarnations busy running away, They could see a incarnation of the beautiful type shouting something.

There was also a familiar face beside her, secretly darkening the surroundings.

Lee Gilyoung, who recognized the face, opened his mouth.

"Would Sooyoung noona be okay?"

"…"

"She went herself. I heard she already used a lot of probability."

Unlike them, who can indirectly interfere with the 41st turn only through the 'Seolhwa Connector' made by Lee Seolhwa, Han Sooyoung infiltrated the story directly.

To be precise, she used [Avatar] to transmit some of her memories, but thanks to that, she was more free than the other members of <Kim Dokja’s Company> in terms of the probability of the scenarios.

—Never connect directly. okay? The 41st turn is different from other world lines. I am the only one who enters that world directly. Do you know what happens to the constellations that descend into the beginning scenarios? Don't even possess incarnations. Save the most probability. I'll save Kim Dokja somehow, so you guys just watch from here.

A method that only writer Han Sooyoung can do.

She made her own [avatar] participate in her 41st turn's scenarios.

In order to get Kim Dokja back, she once again jumped into the hell of the scenarios.

—Never come in. If you really want to see it, just look around like the constellations, okay?

They understood Han Sooyoung's heart, but they couldn't stay still because of the other party.

It was for this reason that Yoo Sangah and Lee Gilyoung entered into a 'behind the scenes contract' with the incarnations in the 41st turn, and Shin Yoosung intervened in the 41st turn through 'possession'. Lee Gilyoung opened his mouth as if passing by.

"You were possessed."

Among the members present here, Shin Yoosung was the only one who could possess the character of the 41st turn using the 'broken film theory'.

"How was it?"

Lee Gilyoung didn't ask specifically, but Shin Yoosung understood.

"You saw it too."

"Because what you see and what you experience are different."

"What do you know?"

She had a lot to say.

The <Star Stream> was still the <Star Stream>.

Scenarios worse than anything they've been through were playing out everywhere.

The goddamn constellations and dokkaebis laughed at the desires of the incarnations, and scorned humans.

Many people died.

Shin Yoosung knew better than anyone why Han Sooyoung had not allowed the group to come there.

"It was a world I never wanted to return to."

Apparently it was. Even so.

"I missed it."

Shin Yoosung answered like that. Lee Gilyoung thought for a moment and then asked.

"Why don't I just come to the 41st turn and descend?"

"Do you want to die? Even now, the probability is already dangerous."

Lee Gilyoung and Shin Yoosung were incarnations who cleared the last scenario.

Their true rank already surpasses even the stars in the high sky.

In such a situation, if he descended into a beginning scenario in another world line, it was obvious what kind of goal he would score.

"I heard that even if Dokja-ssi gets hit by an aftershock, he will hit the ground a couple of times and end up."

"That's ahjussi."

Even Kim Dokja, who is strong in probability, would find it difficult to do such a thing. Lee Gilyoung grumbled.

"Sheesh, I want to have some fun too."

"Fun? Are you doing this for fun?"

Shin Yoosung, furious at Lee Gilyoung's words, frowned. Then Lee Gilyoung asked again.

"Don't you have fun too?"

"I am—"

It's fun, can it be expressed with the same word?

Shin Yoosung bit her lip at the feeling of guilt and guilt that she could not do anything about.

Even so, if she could deny Lee Gilyoung's words now, she didn't have the confidence to do so.

"Going back to the scenarios, honestly, it was fun. Just admit it."

To be thrown into a terrible world, to carry out a life-and-death scenario under the gaze of the constellations.

The moment she was thrown back into the time she never wanted to go through again, Shin Yoosung strangely felt her heart race and blood circulate throughout her body.

Maybe they have become that kind of humans now.

The two looked out the window of the [Industrial Complex]. A cool breeze blew through their hair.

Lee Gilyoung spoke first.

"Sometimes it just doesn’t feel real."

"Huh."

There was a white landscape spreading out of the window.

A world that seems to have been drawn by someone.

Staring at the unfinished landscape, Shin Yoosung recalled the moment they entered this world.

「She thought she could finally get Kim Dokja back.」

Finally reaching the end of the story, <Kim Dokja’s Company> opened the door to the hospital room.

Beyond that door, there were two endings.

One is the world where Kim Dokja exists, and the other is the world where Kim Dokja does not exist.

In front of the two endings, the party chose the latter.

This kind of option is a trap.

The members sensibly thought so.

Just as he did on the subway someday, Kim Dokja will be wandering on the far side of the scenario alone, leaving only sweet illusions for his party.

「Maybe Kim Dokja didn't know that his party would make such a choice.」

The latter would.

This world without Kim Dokja was not a proper world. The world that Kim Dokja's gaze has not fully reached.

A dream that even the oldest dream has never dreamed of.

"It's already been half a year."

Over the past six months, a lot has happened here. The <Kim Dokja's Company> members each embarked on a plan to retrieve Kim Dokja.

—You can connect to all world lines here.

The first to find out this fact was Yoo Sangah, the third person to come over.

Yoo Sangah, who possesses the authority of the 'Guardian of Mandala'', straightly stretched the [thread of bond].

She searched for the soul of Kim Dokja, who was scattered all over the world.

However, the world line was too wide, and there were too many fragments of Kim Dokja scattered.

The party decided to collect the fragments of Kim Dokja who has not yet been reincarnated.

Some fragments were on a world line they knew, and some fragments were on a world line they had never seen before.

All those fragments were traces of Kim Dokja's stay.

Yoo Sangah said.

—If you collect all the fragments, the Kim Dokja we know won't come back.

If you collect someone's footprints, the person who took the footsteps will not come back. Their friends also knew.

Jihye Lee replied:

—But if we don't do that, what's left for us?

Even if this is just the way to mourn Kim Dokja, even if the Kim Dokja they know will never come back.

Like the days when they waited for Yoo Joonghyuk to leave for space someday, they wanted to continue their eternal hope.

So, the party continued to collect fragments of Kim Dokja's stories.

The fragments gradually grew in mass, and when they reached a certain level, they began to move somewhere as if they were attracted by gravitational force.

The party searched for the direction the story was headed and finally found a world line.

'41'.

That world was not the world recorded in Ways of Survival. A world that has not been recorded like Yoo Joonghyuk's 0th turn.

The companions instinctively realized.

Maybe there is Kim Dokja here.

"Did the sooty bastard contact you yet?"

"Not yet. And stop calling Yoo Joonghyuk-ssi that way. It’s arrogant." Shin Yoosung said, staring blankly at the scenery outside the window.

She stared and stared again. Looking at it like that, Lee Gilyoung asked as if his white coat would flutter in that white landscape.

"Can we find him?

"Yes. We already found one."

"That's not hyung."

"...Then who is ahjussi?"

"Hyung..."

What is Kim Dokja?

Shin Yooyoung and Lee Gilyoung knew the answer.

They were familiar with Kim Dokja.

Kim Dokja's likes, dislikes, dishes he can't eat, height, age, weight, facial expression and smile he made when seeing them.

But if they collect all of them, will he become Kim Dokja?

If they collect all of Kim Dokja's memories, will it become a being that can be named Kim Dokja?

One day, Lee Seolhwa asked,

—Do you remember the lunch we had a week ago?

Shin Yoosung shook her head. Then Lee Seolhwa asked again.

—I don't remember either. So, am I no longer Lee Seolhwa?

That question shocked Shin Yoosung. The disturbing questions she had been harboring all this time swirled in her head.

Perhaps the 'Kim Dokja' she knows does not exist in the world anymore.

As the 'Shin Yoosung' from 1 year ago, 2 years ago, and 3 years ago is no longer in the world.

They definitely existed once, but aren't they only left in the story now?

She didn't want to think about anything complicated.

Even so, thinking of Kim Dokja, Shin Yoosung couldn't help but think of such a thing.

What is Kim Dokja?

「There is a story I haven’t read yet. I'll be back soon.」

Kim Dokja left such a note. Therefore, Shin Yoosung already knew Lee Gilyoung's answer.

"My hyung is a person who likes stories."

As if satisfied with his answer, Lee Gilyoung nodded his head several times and added.

"Hyung likes my story."

"Wouldn’t he like my story better?"

"No. He prefers my story."

The two started arguing again.

Shin Yoosung thought.

In this world, conflict soon becomes a story. And stories are Kim Dokja's favorite things.

If Kim Dokja really likes stories, he will definitely see them now.

No matter what he looks like, if he sees this story, Shin Yoosung will surely get her star back.

How long had they been talking like that?

Lee Seolhwa's voice was heard through the broadcasting in the industrial complex.

—He’s back.

He’s back. At those words, Shin Yoosung and Lee Gilyoung held their breath.

No way.

However, there is no way that Kim Dokja has returned. That means—

Along with a beep, they heard someone grab a microphone.

—Gather. I have something to say.

Yoo Joonghyuk is back.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 650 Episode 19 People of the Past (2)

A total of three responded to Yoo Joonghyuk's call.

They were Lee Seolhwa, Shin Yoosung, and Lee Gilyoung.

"Sooty bastard! Where have you been wandering around now?"

As soon as he entered the conference room, Lee Gilyoung pointed with his finger.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at Lee Gilyoung and muttered as he turned his head.

"This guy is becoming more and more like Kim Namwoon."

"Hey, what did you just say!"

Shin Yoosung gave a bad look to Lee Gilyoung, who was fighting back.

"Stay still."

Lee Gilyoung shouted as if it was unfair, and Shin Yoosung admonished Lee Gilyoung.
Lee Seolhwa looked at the two kids and asked with a sigh.

"But where have you been?"

"Another world line."

"Which word line?"

"I went outside of the <Star Stream>."

Outside of the <Star Stream>

I had never heard of a place like that.

"Is there a place like that?"

"I can go from here."

This world is 'a world without Kim Dokja'.

Therefore, the Oldest Dream and the binding power of <Star Stream> are weak here.

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned for a moment as if thinking about a troublesome problem, then asked,

"Where did Han Sooyoung and Yoo Sangah go?"

"They are in the 41st turn."

"What about Lee Jihye?"

"She’s in a different world line. There are fragments of Kim Dokja that I could not collect."

"There is no need to collect the fragments anymore, right?"

"Of course not."

<Kim Dokja Company> toured the world lines and collected the fragments that remained in the state of a story that could not be reincarnated.

Each had their assigned area, and the device created as a result of the harvest was the 'Story Connector'.

A device combining the stories left by Kim Dokja to track the real Kim Dokja.

Of course, the term 'the real Kim Dokja' was somewhat ambiguous. No one knows what the real Kim Dokja is.

What is certain, however, is that there is a 'main theme' that is the core of Kim Dokja in the direction this story connector is heading.

"It would be better to ask for Lee Jihye to come back. It's not good to stay outside the world line too long."

Among the members of <Kim Dokja Company>, Lee Jihye was especially free.

She had a lot of emotional ups and downs, and a bit of a wanderlust.

"She's an adult now. She must be thinking a lot."

Yoo Joonghyuk thought about Lee Jihye for a while.

Fragments of Kim Dokja are literally scattered all over the world line, and some of them are where the scenario is in progress.

Perhaps Lee Jihye is watching one of those world lines.

Her goals that she did not achieve. Her friend she couldn't save. The constellations.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk knew very well what the constellation buried in such remorse would end up experiencing.

"In case you don't know, it would be better to trace the world line Lee Jihye went to."

"All right."

"Lee Hyunsung and Jung Heewon?"

"They didn't come this way."

At Lee Seolhwa's words, Yoo Joonghyuk and Shin Yoosung and Lee Gilyoung, who had been quarreling, also shut their mouths.

Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsung.

<Kim Dokja Company>'s sword and shield.

The two people who always protected the party did not make the same choice this time.

"But I don't think they've chosen another portal."

"How do you know?"

"You can observe the possibilities of all world lines here, right?"

In other words, if Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsung entered the 'World with Kim Dokja', they could know that fact here as well.

However, the possibility of such a world scenario was not observed.

"The two of them haven't chosen yet."

Who in <Kim Dokja Company> did not choose the 'world where Kim Dokja returned'.

Perhaps everyone instinctively realized it.

This world can't be happy that easily. It is because the 'simple happiness' that has tempted them so far has been a trap. They didn't even know if the happiness they were looking for was at the end of the road.

But they kept walking and finally came to this place.

Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsung must have been a little tired on the road.

"Who are the others"

"I don't know yet. Maybe the constellations will come. They may have already come."

If it was a constellation that would come over that portal to help <Kim Dokja Company>, the list was obvious.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk did not expect any help from the constellations.

"Don't trust the constellations. They're only attracted to fleeting stories and drawn around like moths."

"But without them, we wouldn't have seen the ending."

"How is the progress of the 41st round?"

Lee Seolhwa silently presented the scenario record and access log.

It contained the events that had happened from the start of the scenario for the 41st round until now, as well as the access records of Kim Dokja's Company.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who read the full text obsessively, said with a cold expression.

"You're doing something pathetic. You had a chance to end the world line. Why didn't you actively intervene?"

When she pointed to a part of the scenario record, a scenario screen floated over the text. Cheon Inho's face appeared on the screen.

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes widened momentarily.

"This guy is—"

"Who does he look like?"

To Lee Seolhwa's question, Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer. As if checking weathered memories over time, he just stared at that face for a long time.

Slowly turning from the screen, Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st round appeared.

A being who hates constellations and dreams of the destruction of the <Star Stream>.

The culprit who sent Shin Yoosung to the past in the 41st round to become a disaster.

"The 41st round must end. That's how it's meant to be."

"…That could change."

It was Shin Yoosung who said that.

"Both Dokja-ssi and we have changed the story several times. Without the 1,863 times that have been changed, we wouldn't be here."

"You should know. If you change the 41st round, the divergence of the world lines will increase more."

If you save a few people in front of you, another world that existed only as a possibility will be born. A world where more deaths and tragedies are confirmed.

"The law that that world must be unhappy is-"

"This is the world I came from."

Everyone shut up.

No one here could raise an objection to Yoo Joonghyuk.

He had been repeating the scenarios longer than anyone else in the world, and he knew the world's tragedies better than anyone else.

"It's better to end it as soon as possible. Only then can a bigger tragedy be prevented. If the world line diverges further here, the balance of the universe will collapse. Too many derivative world lines have already been created in this universe."

"But whether we intervene or not, anyway, more world lines are being created since you're a regressor."

Yoo Joonghyuk's regressions.

And with his regression, a new 'world line' is born.

That is the tragedy and absolute law that is the foundation of this <Star Stream>.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk shook his head.

"The 42nd round of that guy doesn't exist."

"What? How do you know?"

"If he continues to regress, then the world line after it must continue to exist. Just like the Secretive Plotter did."

Secretive Plotter.

After 1,863 regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk found the reason behind him.

If Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round had continued to return even after sending Shin Yoosung to the past, he would have been reborn as an absolute god like Secretive Plotter.

"However, his next world line is nowhere to be found."

The world line that Yoo Joonghyuk continued to regress from the 41st round could be found nowhere in the universe.

After that, the world line of 'Ways of Survival', derived by Shin Yoosung, who went back to the past in the 41st round, continues.

"Then what happened to the Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round?"

"My conclusion is this. The 'I' of the 41st round stopped regressing on his own."

"But how? I can't believe he reached the end of the scenarios in the 41st round."

"It can't be. The record of failure is too obvious."

He recalled of the words of Shin Yoosung in the 41st round, who descended as the Disaster of Floods.

"I, in the 41st round, was in deep despair during the scenario, and realized that the end could not be seen as it is. That's why I sent Shin Yoosung to the past."

The 41st round's Yoo Joonghyuk tried to reach the end of the scenarios by sacrificing his peers, but in the end he failed to achieve his goal, and he knew that he would never be able to achieve that goal.

So, he sent Shin Yoosung to his past self before his mind was further damaged.

That is how the 'Ways of Survival' began.

"Then it makes no more sense. The man in the 41st round did not reach the end of the scenarios, how did he stop the regressions?"

"I don't know that either."

Yoo Joonghyuk thought for a moment and then looked at the window.

"Maybe that's why Kim Dokja is there."

A person who loves stories more than anyone else in this universe, he is there to find this forgotten world line and see its end.

"However, there is a way to guess."

The surprised party widened their eyes.

If you think about it, it might have been a natural thing.

He could have been the only one who knew the secret of Yoo Joonghyuk who does not return anymore.

"I will go to the 41st round myself."

He is a regressor who has seen the end of the scenarios.

The strongest incarnation on earth who cleared the 1,864th round and 1,865th round, and defeated even those mythical constellations.

Because it was 'Yoo Joonghyuk' and not another person, the party had no choice but to believe his words.

But there was one problem.

"Joonghyuk-ssi can't go to that world."

"Why?"

Lee Seolhwa let out a light sigh and laughed at Yoo Joonghyuk.

His muscles much tighter than before. A far-off gap that naturally oozes out between those muscles.

"Joonghyuk-ssi is too strong."

The current Yoo Joonghyuk consumed enormous probability just by existing.

The 41st round is now only in the early scenarios.

Even if only a historical-grade constellation descended, a storm of probability would come, and if Yoo Joonghyuk descended in the 41st round, a global catastrophic aftermath would blow.

As a result, Yoo Joonghyuk himself would not be able to avoid extinction, and Yoo Joonghyuk nodded as if he knew.

"I have no intention of entrusting Han Sooyoung with that work forever."

"Joonghyuk-ssi and Sooyoung-ssi are doing their best right now-"

"Did the guy who was doing his best make such a pathetic mistake? He let go of the opportunity to finish the 41st round."

The video remaining in the machine began to be output in real time.

"Tell me that you received it well."

The roof of the theater dungeon. After Han Sooyoung glanced back at Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho of the 41st turn who had collapsed, they were disappearing over the land.

"Tell Han Sooyoung and Yoo Sangah that they have only one job to do."

As if there was no need to look further, Yoo Joonghyuk looked away from the log and walked to the long family behind him.

"Creating the conditions for me to descend."

Standing tall in front of a large window, Yoo Joonghyuk looked out the window with his unique gaze.

The companions watched his back in silence.

Is it because of the pure white background outside the window?

His figure looked like a single letter written on a wide blank sheet of paper.

"I will personally bring back Kim Dokja."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 651 Episode 19 People of the Past (3)

I thought about my parents.

When I was young, I was given homework to draw a picture under the theme of 'family' at school.

I remember it as being a pretty embarrassing homework assignment.

Because at that time, I was not good at drawing people's faces. When I tried to think of someone's face, strangely, only a pale mosaic face came to mind.

So instead of my parents, I drew myself standing under the deep dark night sky.

「"Why did Hakhyun draw only himself?"」

When the teacher asked me that, I replied that I drew my parents.

Looking back now, it might have been the manifestation of my literary talent.

A deep, warm night sky with a few twinkling stars

A cozy darkness that seems to embrace me no matter what I do.

Although there are no detailed shapes or faces, the people who were clearly there and cared for me.

Looking back, I wonder if it wasn't because of my parents that I first started writing a novel.

「"Why do stories exist?"」

To that question, my mother replied:

「"Hmm. Stories are for world peace."」

A story for world peace.

「"If everyone would read the stories and talk about the stories, there would be no wars or strife."」

「"Why?"」

「"Because the story is fictional."」

For the world to be peaceful, everyone must read novels.

At first I didn't understand what that meant.

「"Lee Hakhyun. Don't play with your phone, come here."」

But going to school and meeting my friends

「"Why do you keep talking to the dog?"」

「"But isn’t Lee Hakhyun also a bit gloomy?"」

Being bullied for not bullying someone else together.

「"Lee Hakhyun. I'll have to bring your parents tomorrow."」

As I listened to the teacher's criticism for not clearing up the misunderstanding even though I hadn't done anything wrong, I understood my mother's words for the first time.

「"Hakhyun's parents are a bit peculiar."」

「"Tsk. Anyway, son and parents are the same."」

People really like stories.

In a place where an incident does not exist, they create an incident, exaggerate it, and even distort it to develop a story.

They are enjoying the process of someone in front of them getting hurt and falling apart.

And all of that is quickly forgotten.

Perhaps it was at that time that I began to write novels.

Instead of hating people, let's write novels.

Let's write really interesting novels, and let the whole world talk about my novels all the time.

I wrote and wrote like that.

Finally, around the age of 23, I made my debut.

When I visited my parents with the news of my debut, the first expression my parents made.

My memories were hazy like a pale mosaic, but the emotion contained in that expression came to mind clearly.

「"Yes, that's how it happened."」

Why?

The faces of my parents who read my novel looked somewhat sad.

Naturally, I knew they would be happy, but I was confused. What did I do wrong? Did something in my novel make them sad?

My parents hugged me silently. I couldn't understand that feeling, so I left the house that way.

It's funny when I think about it now.

Perhaps my parents were worried about how I would make a living as a pure literature writer.

As a result, I met Ji Eunyu and became a web novel writer, so my parents' concerns may have been correct.

「"Author-nim. You can't start the intro like this."」

Ji Eunyu was a patient editor.

「"What if you unravel the main character's past for such a long time?"」

The correction was basic, and she spared no criticism when the development was strange or when there was an utterance that did not suit the character.

Hundreds of manuscripts were rejected, and dozens of other works were returned for thousands of reasons.

I wrote it, and she edited it. So one or two works piled up.

「"Writer! It's done! It's a success!"」

One day, a story came to us.

「"Did you know? This is the first time! It's the first time in our management that we won a promotion like this!"」

It was her first successful work that she and I created together.

Even Ji Eunyu, who has been calm throughout the writing, couldn't hide her excitement in front of her sales index she had never seen before.

On the day the work began to be paid for, we sat side by side in the management chair with the lights off and read readers' comments together.

Not all of the comments were comments of support, but we were happy that day.

Although I didn't know it, I must have been as trembling as Kim Dokja at the moment he first became a Constellation.

「"Editor-nim. By the way."」

But why am I remembering the story of that day now?

As Ji Eunyu advised, it would be difficult to talk about this for a long time.

「"People keep asking if Kim Dokja is me. What does that mean?"」

"Huh!"

When I jumped up with a strange scream, my surroundings were covered in pitch black darkness.

I had a strange dream.

I think it was a dream about my parents and Ji Eunyu.

As I relaxed my shoulders lightly and looked around me, I felt a heavy sensation in my right thigh.

When I turned on the light on my smartphone, I saw Shin Yoosung leaned over who fell asleep.

Several memories came one after another.

In order to collect Sangpyeong Tongbo, I entered the 'Field of Nagak', and met Shin Yoosung there.

There, I helped Shin Yoosung to deal with the Ancient Nagak.

I used [Enhance Sentence] to tame the Ancient Nagak. I even remember that I [incited] myself as Shin Yoosung'…

My memory after that wasn't clear.

Is it a side effect of [Incite]?

"Shin Yoosung, are you okay?"

When I lightly shook Shin Yoosung's shoulder, the child quickly opened her eyes.

"Ah, you're awake...!"

Looking at Shin Yoosung's smiling expression, I felt chills.

Why?

Fortunately, that feeling quickly dissipated.

"Yes. Are you uninjured?"

"Yes, thank you!"

Fortunately, it seems that we cleared the 'Field of Nagak' without much trouble.

In the meantime, the message log was pushed back for a long time.

[You are the first to hunt more than 500 'Nagaks'!]

[Cleared the 1-person dungeon.]

[You have obtained 2 tokens as a basic reward.]

[We have acquired 8 additional Sangpyeong Tongbo as a mass slaughter bonus for Nagak.]

[As a special reward, you acquired the exclusive skill 'Breath'.]

Exclusive Skill [Breath].

Although it is a full-time skill that makes you hold your breath for up to 30 minutes with a single breath, it is a useful skill when you have to go through a contaminated area or engage in underwater battles.

[You have succeeded in hunting down the 'Hidden Boss' in the 1-person dungeon.]

[You will receive an additional reward.]

Even got an additional reward by hunting the hidden boss of the 'one-person dungeon - Ancient Nargak'

[Obtained the 'Provocation Fire Flute'.]

The flute of provocation. An item that greatly reduces the enemy's mental strength when used, and gathers scattered enemies in one place.

I honestly don't know where to use this.

It's not like I'm strong, and if I had to drive normal monsters to one place, I'd die like a dog.

I'll have to give it to Kyung Sein later.

The messages weren't over.

There was still a bounty scenario left.

[Sub scenario 'Precious Hair' is done!]

[You have obtained 2,000 coins as a reward.]

[Additionally, when you offer 'Ancient Nagak's Meat', 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' will give you a special reward.]

Come to think of it, this scenario ends when you give that constellation the ancient Nagak's meat.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is expecting the 'Ancient Nagak's Meat'.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' looks at the 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' pathetically.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' says he would like you to cook it for him if possible.]

I hesitated for a moment, then muttered into the air.

"It's going to take a few days to do it. Is that okay?"

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' says he can wait that long.]

This bought me some time.

By the way, when I got out of the dungeon, the Ancient Nagaks disappeared, so how do I consecrate the meat of the ancient horns?

While I was lost in my thoughts, Shin Yoosung brushed her butt and stood up.

"Thank you, Ahjussi. Thanks to that, I can now do it for one person."

Shin Yoosung smiled brightly as she looked down at Sangpyeong Tongbo, which she had acquired herself.

But I couldn't laugh.

"Are you going back to your original group?"

"Ah yes… I decided to do that with the adults..."

The reason Shin Yoosung entered the 'One-Man Dungeon' was to prove her worth to the adults in her group.

Now that the proof is complete, Shin Yoosung will be able to become an official member of the group.

"I'm not asking the grown-ups' opinions, but Shin Yoosung's intentions. Do you really want to be in that group?"

A smart Shin Yoosung would have understood the meaning of my question. However, some children are so smart that they come up with answers that others don't even have in mind.

"The adults in the group said. They say that they don't discriminate based on their age, but if they have ability, they're people who treat them as much as they have ability-"

I know what you want to say, but I don't need to hear more.

"Shin Yoosung."

"Yes, yes?"

"Would you like to come with me if it's okay?"

Shin Yoosung looked up at me with her eyes wide open. I gave the child enough time to think. After a while, Shin Yoosung asked in a small voice.

"Can I?"

"Yes, of course."

"But I won't be of much help."

"If it wasn’t for Shin Yoosung, I would be dead."

"That helped me…"

Shin Yoo-seung bit her lip and murmured while lowering her head.

"You don't even know who I am..."

What drove this child to this extent?

「"Something like a devil."」

「"These days, young children are more toxic. They are kids who survived after killing people in the first scenario."」

「"If you can’t trust her, she should be useful. Put her in the dungeon. If she survives, let's take her."」

「"Poisonous things should be caught properly from an early age."」

Even without [The Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], I could read the words echoing in the child's head.

I opened my mouth as if in protest.

"No, I do."

"Yes?"

"I know what kind of person Shin Yoosung is."

"How..."

If you ask me how I know, there are no words to explain.

「"Ahjussi."」

「"I will not give up. Just like Ahjussi saved me time and time again."」

「"My name is Shin Yoosung. Shin Yoosung from <Kim Dokja Company>."」

I've read and rewrote a lot of sentences about you, I can answer that.

But that wouldn't be an appropriate thing for Shin Yoosung now.

Who is in front of me right now is not 'Shin Yoosung in the 3rd round', but 'Shin Yoosung in the 41st round'.

「"What were we to the captain?"」

「"I hate you for living alone in the world."」

「"There is only one thing I can tell you now. The captain can't save anyone."」

She was the one who followed Yoo Joonghyuk more than anyone else.

That's why she couldn't stand the feeling of betrayal.

She is someone who has grown with hatred by wandering around the world lines for thousands of years.

A person who appeared as a disaster in the third round.

「"Baat!"」

The person who became Kim Dokja's daughter.

The person who was reincarnated as a dokkaebi and told the story of <Kim Dokja's Company> to <Star Stream>.

「However, it was a story that hadn't happened yet.」

That's why I know Shin Yoosung well, but I don't know much about Shin Yoosung in front of me.

"Even if I don't know who you are, I'm going to trust you."

So that was all I could promise.

Shin Yoosung looked up at me blankly, then she averted her gaze and said:

"… I think I can trust you too."

[The character Shin Yoosung shows strong trust in you.]

Shin Yoosung, who had been twitching her little hand for a while, asked.

"Then… Do you have a group too?"

"Would you like to join my group?"

"That, is that okay? But to join the group, you have to get permission from the king…"

"I am the king."

At my words, Shin Yoosung sighed and took a small breath. Then she took a couple of steps away from me and started shaking her shoulders.

I know very well what kind of being the 'king' of the last group was.

"There is nothing to be nervous about. As you can see, I'm just an ordinary ahjussi. I just picked up a flag by accident."

If Cheon Inho looked a little nicer, my words would be more persuasive.

I used my narrow eyes to draw as good an arc as possible.

"It's scary because you smile like that."

"Sorry."

"Can I really join?"

"Sure."

When I agreed, Shin Yoosung, who was briefly thinking about something, said in a determined voice.

"Then I want to join."

[Incarnation 'Shin Yoosung' has become a member of your group.]

I couldn't turn a blind eye to Shin Yoosung…

I may be beaten to death by Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round later, but I believe this is the right decision for now.

"The other group members haven't joined yet, so it looks like we'll both be four for the time being."

Shin Yoosung nodded her head vigorously as if she liked it.

After clearing the 'One-Man Dungeon', what's left is the 'Sangpyeong Tongbo' we collected to enter the 'field of the Big Dipper'.

Looking for a seat in the lobby, I thought for a moment about Shin Yoosung.

This is the 41st round not recorded in 'Ways of Survival'.

In this round, Shin Yoosung, the 'Disaster of Floods' who went to Kronos won't appear.

Then, who will be the disaster of the 'fifth scenario'?

As soon as the 10 Sangpyeong Tonggi were inserted into the entrance of the lobby, a dim light began to permeate the lobby.

"I'm going to enter the Hidden Dungeon. It could be dangerous, would you mind?"

Since the entrance to the National Palace Museum had collapsed anyway, I couldn’t try to escape.

I had no choice but to clear the dungeon.

If even one person clears this dungeon, the remaining members will be automatically summoned out of the museum.

"It's okay. I was prepared for that much."

As I looked at the child who spoke resolutely, a corner of my chest was sore.

I didn't wait any longer and used the Sangpyeong tongbos.

[You can advance to the hidden chapter by using 10 prize reports.]

[Would you like to enter the hidden chapter, 'Field of the Big Dipper'?]

"Enter."

I couldn't find any traces of other kings either in the National Museum of Korea or in the 'Field of Nagaks'.

In other words, other kings have already collected 10 pieces of Sangpyeong Tongbo and entered the field of the Big Dipper.

"The culprit who destroyed the museum must also be in this dungeon."

I blinked and my vision wavered.

I imagined the scenery that would soon unfold.

「The white lobby has been transformed into a wide, open waiting room. There were seven doors at the end of the waiting room.」

After a while, an open waiting room appeared as explained in the main story when reading.

However, there was one thing that was different from the main story.

With a cool sense of tension, I narrowed my eyes even more.

In the 'Field of the Big Dipper', we have collect all the star jewels scattered across the seven gates to summon the 'Death Sword'.

So the waiting room had to have a total of seven doors according to the number of star jewels.

「But now, there was only one door visible in the waiting room.」

The scenario had changed.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 652 Episode 19 People of the Past (4)

I stared at the door created at the end of the waiting room.

There was only one door when there should have been seven.

Is this the original progression of the 41st round of Ways of Survival, or is it because something has changed as I and the readers intervened?

If it was the original development of 'Ways of Survival', it was normal for the 'Ways of Survival' skill to activate at this point. However, the 'Ways of Survival' skill was quiet.

That means that the readers intervened and the scenario changed.

「Someone deliberately changed the plot.」

But did the readers I know carelessly intervene in the scenario?

Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Ye Hyunwoo, Killer King, Literature Girl, Koo Seonah, Kim Kyungsik.

Calmly recalling the list, it never occurred to me that any of them might have been involved in the cataclysm of the scenario.

What readers are ahead of the characters is 'information', and they will not try to change the future too much in order to actively utilize the development of the original story.

In other words, the readers are not the culprits.

If so, who changed the scenario and caused the event of ‘the' collapse of the museum' that did not exist in the original story?

I made a hypothesis.

「Somewhere in this world, if there are people who don’t want the development of the scenario to go the way it was written.」

What if there are people who are at a disadvantage as time goes by when following the development of 'Omniscient Reader'?

Once the hypothesis was established, it felt like the outline of the culprit became clearer.

But it wasn't quite yet certain.

"Ahjussi."

With a trembling voice, Shin Yoosung joined me.

There were so many corpses on the floor of the waiting room that there was no place to step on.

It seemed that a fight had already taken place.

I wrapped my arms around Shin Yoosung’s shoulders and walked forward cautiously. I didn't forget to look at the faces of the people around me. I was afraid that there might be a face I knew among them.

Dansu ahjussi.

Kim Kyungsik and Koo Seonah.

And someone I don't know who they possessed, my editor.

In an instant, the back of my neck went cold.

Reflexively, I bent down and wrapped my arms around Shin Yoosung.

Three daggers grazed my neck and flew to the other side of the waiting room.

When I narrowed my eyes, I saw assassins rising among the corpses.

"Jet, did you miss it?"

They were new hunters.

Instead of entering the dungeon, they hid in the waiting room and killed new recruits.

There were people similar in 'Omniscient Reader'.

Hiding Shin Yoosung behind me, I activated the tale of the Beggar Sect.

[Story, the tenacious Murim master' stutters.]

The spirit of the master of Murim rose sharply, and the number of enemies hidden among the corpses were transmitted through my skin.

A number over twenty.

It was a level of troops that could be called a 'small group'.

"Hmm? That kid…"

I could see some of them exchanging whispers, as if they recognized Shin Yoosung.

I asked Shin Yoosung in a small voice.

"Are they people you know?"

"Yes."

A small tremor came from Shin Yoosung, who grabbed my sleeve.

I asked again.

"Looks like people you don’t want to know anymore."

The answer came back after a while.

"....Yes."

I changed 'thought' to 'Broken Faith' in preparation for an emergency.

Meanwhile, the assassins exchanged opinions quickly.

"Could it be that you went through that series of battles alone?"

"Didn’t I tell you? These days, kids are more toxic."

Right.

These people were the adults of the 'union' that tried to put Shin Yoosung in the group.

One of the assassins, who had been watching us closely, came forward with a dagger.

"You. Do you have a group?"

"I do."

To say that I have no group here would only make me be looked down on by them.

However, even when I said that I had a group, they didn't seem to care.

"You came here by yourself when you have a group?"

"I am confident in my skills."

It was a provocative answer, but several assassins unexpectedly nodded.

"If you came over with a kid, there's a high possibility that you're from a one-person dungeon."

"The single-person dungeon difficulty is more difficult."

"It's worth having as an ally."

The Assassin Leader, who quickly gathered opinions, nodded.

"We respect talented people. Please leave your group and move on to this group."

Suddenly, Shin Yoosung's words came to mind. If 'union' is unconditionally skill-first, this…

"I'll accept both you and her. It looks like you've developed a special relationship."

Speech that seems to be condescending.

I glared at him with my eyes narrowed.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

First of all, it is not a 'reader'.

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Perjury

Age: 35

Constellation support: Legendary Assassin

Exclusive Attribute: Assassin (Normal)

Exclusive Skills: [Ambush Lv.3], [Gidobinic Lv.3], [Weapon Improvement Lv.2]

Stigma: [Scheduled Special Lv.1], [Silver Bullet Lv.2], [Shadow Stealth Lv.2]

Overall stats: [Health Lv. 20], [Strength Lv.25], [Agility Lv.25], [Magic Power Lv.21]

Comprehensive evaluation: It is an incarnation of the union. He is active as one of the 7 kings of Seoul.

He was the first person I saw. He must have been one of the extras in 'Ways of Survival'.

His supportive Constellation is...

...Legendary Assassin.

It was a constellation that had never appeared in 'Omniscient Reader'.

[Exclusive skill 'Three ways to survive in a ruined world' is activated!]

Fortunately, the 'Ways of Survival' skill was activated in time.

「Legendary Assassin, the modifier is grandiose, but among those who have become constellations, there is no Constellation without Legend. In other words, it's an ordinary

historical-grade constellation.」

Huh. Right.

「This is a sponsor that is common among assassins, and like the 'Monarch of the Small Fries', random incarnations are sprinkled with background selection and then reaped as assassins. They often lend their grown incarnations to other constellations as mercenaries.」

I know who his sponsor is.

I was thinking of saving myself a bit if there was an Myth-grade constellation behind him, but I think I can go out strong with this level.

"I'm sorry, but I have no intention of joining your group."

"Even though we're a group of 'Seoul Gwang'? You've probably heard of the union, right?"

The union.

Could it be that the group that Ye Hyunwoo was talking about were these guys?

I nodded and asked.

"This is where the Tyrant King resides, right?"

The man who subtly frowned at the name of the Tyrant King said.

"We are under the command of the 'Assassin King'."

Assassin King?

There is no such name among the 7 kings of Seoul I know.

"You don't seem to know how big of an opportunity this is, but we will soon retrieve the 'Sword of Death' and obtain the 'Absolute Throne'. I don't know where your group is, but at this point there are no forces greater than ours. You'd better make a wise choice."

I replied with a dry nod.

"I hear you. But it doesn't go below that. I have no intention of fighting, so please pass on your troops."

It was half sincere.

There was a bit of fatigue left after passing through the 'Field of Nagak', and even if it were me, it was not easy to subdue twenty assassins without a single wound. And above all,

「I didn't want to kill people if possible.」

Even if I control myself with [Incite], there is a limit. Killing people for whatever reason is never a pleasant experience.

The reason why Kim Dokja at the beginning of Omniscient Reader chose to become the 'King of no killing' seemed to be understood a little now.

Of course, the assassin who didn't even know who Kim Dokja was wasn't going to listen to me.

"Then die here."

I smiled with my eyes wide open.

"No compromise? Aren't we members of society?"

"Society has already perished."

I don't know who is in charge of the alliance, but why did they make all the members of the group look like Kim Namwoon?

"I'm still a member of society."

"Then die as a member of society."

It can't be.

I made a quick calculation in my head.

Should I use [Incite]?

Or, should I start by eliminating that guy with the 'Blade of Faith'?

As I secretly tried to carry out a strategy with a way to wipe out these people at once without hurting Shin Yoosung, Shin Yoosung pulled my sleeves.

"Ahjussi."

Looking back, Shin Yoosung's eyes shimmered with golden energy. My head throbbed, and a sense of dizziness passed through my head.

I think something similar happened before.

"I'll just finish it."

Why? At that moment, Shin Yoosung seemed like a completely different person from the Shin Yoosung I knew.

"Finish it... how?"

"Therefore…"

It was then that a roar rang out from inside the waiting room.

"Get out of the way!"

Suddenly, the door to the waiting room opened. A crowd poured out.

"What…"

With a booming sound, the assassin's head shattered. The astonished assassins screamed.

"What, what is it?"

The assassins wandered around and raised their swords.

But whenever the sound of wind was heard in the air, the number of assassins was steadily decreasing. The awe-inspiring assassins clung to the walls and shouted loudly.

"Who! Who dares-"

A series of group members appeared through the pouring pit.

Leading the group members was a giant.

There was an iron pipe embracing the dazzling light of the giant's fish, and at a glance it was an S-class item.

"King of gangsters!"

King of gangsters?

No matter how much I searched in my head, there was no king with such a nickname.

「A person who did not appear in Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.」

I was nervous and watched the development of the situation. Looking closely, the wind was blowing from the right side of the group.

Four kitchen knives that moved in a zigzag pattern cut through the air.

"Ah! Heartless Mother!"

Heartless Mother. This was also the first time I had ever heard this nickname. A dazzling passing technique performed by a mother and daughter each holding a pair of kitchen knives. It was a terrifying sight just to look at from a distance.

However… What?

I was used to the mother and daughter's faces.

"Inhopa group! Inhopa is back!"

Inhopa?

"Aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa-"

A few terrified assassins tried to run screaming into the dungeon, but their lives were lost.

Now, the number of assassins left in the waiting room was less than five.

The assassin who was threatening me earlier growled.

"King of gangsters! We are an alliance. Do you think you'll be safe after doing this to us?"

"If you all die, who will know what I did?"

"Ooh, there are those who watched us suffer."

Then, the gangster king's party looked around the edge of the waiting room.

Some of the incarnations who watched the situation with a bonfire were there.

"Are you going to tell about it?"

The incarnations all shook their heads at the gangster king's despair.

"We didn't see anything."

"Yes, you guys-"

Before the bewildered assassin could shout anything, an iron pipe shattered his head.

Watching the assassin collapse powerlessly, the king of gangsters spat out curse words.

"Eh, wicked bastards."

"Looking at it, it seems that he was persecuting newcomers again."

"Anyway, that's what all the alliance scum do."

I was honestly surprised. Anyway, I heard that the 'Union' is the strongest force at the moment.

But is there a rebel group that fights against the alliance with only a single force?

I saw the gangster king who spotted us and was approaching us.

"Boss, are you okay?"

It was difficult to immediately recognize his face as it was soaked in blood, but the man's long, rough, all-back hair caught my eye immediately.

When I saw it up close, I laughed out loud.

No wonder. So, was it Inhopa?

"Uh?"

The gangster king, who had approached us, opened his eyes wide at me. I was wrong in my guess that he was a person who did not appear in the 'Omniscient Reader'.

Because the man was someone I already knew.

A person who changed the scenario but is neither a reader nor a member of the Misreading association.

In 'Omniscient Reader', he was just an extra villain, let alone a king, and a man who died tragically as a petty gangster.

"It’s you, bro?"

I nodded and replied.

"Bang Cheolsoo."

The action leader of Geumho Station.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' welcomes you.]

People who knew me came running to welcome me. Incarnations of Geumho Station, including Dayoung and Dayoung's mother.

Those who had killed each other for their own safety now formed a group to help the weak.

Once again, I realized that this story is not the 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' that I knew.

[A new loss is recorded on the 'last wall'.]

Shin Yoosung, who was standing next to me, was looking at the same scenery with blank eyes.

"Brother! Uuuuuuuuu! You’re alive!"

"Inho ahjussi."

Looking at Dayoung and her mother waving their hands and people shouting at me, I thought about the story.

"Do you know how much we found!"

I no longer believe that stories can keep world peace like my parents said.

No matter how many funny stories there are in the world, people will still start a war and hate someone.

But, nonetheless, I continue to think.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' nods.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' sometimes says that this kind of story isn't bad.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' agrees with his lips twitching.]

Because at least someone reads the story and changes.

[The losses you recorded will come to fruition.]

[You acquired a new attribute!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 653 Episode 19 People of the Past (5)

Finally got a new attribute.

[Acquisition of a legendary Attribute!]

It was even a legendary attribute.

I muttered 'attribute window' in my mind, and almost simultaneously.

[Attribute window cannot be activated due to current system error.]

It reminded me of the fact that I, like Kim Dokja, have limited access to my system window.

[Acquired the attribute 'Record Repairer'!]

But fortunately, this time the name of the acquired attribute immediately came to mind.

'Record repaired'.

It was a feature I had never seen before.

[The attribute 'Record Repairer' is activated!]

['Record Repairer' is affected by the losses you have acquired'.]

[The 'Record Repairer' begins mending your lost records.]

Mend my missing records?

[1 hour and 30 minutes to complete record repair.]

I don't know what it means, but after an hour and thirty minutes, something will change.

[Someone noticed that a new record-repairer was born.]

[The 'Recorders of Fear' have recognized your existence.]

Then came a suspicious message.

As far as I know, a 'Recorder of Fear' is a writer who left a record of the divinity of the other world.

It was their common name.

But did they recognize me?

Could it be that the 'Recorders of Fear' can also see incarnations like the constellations?

[Some 'Recorders of Fear' consider your existence a threat.]

Am I a threat?

I don't know.

The information available at this time was too limited.

All I can know now is that the people of Geumho Station who died in the third round survived here.

"Inho-ssi! Were you alive?"

"Keuheuk! Brother!"

Shin Yoosung, whose golden eyes disappeared before I knew it, asked me.

"Are these people you know?"

I nodded lightly

By the way, Bang Cheolsoo, this bastard, has been grossly attached to me for too long.

I lightly smacked the back of the head of the water-proof man who had buried his head in my arm.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' sponsored 100 coins.]

It's still there.

---

Have there been many things accumulated in the past? Bang Cheolsoo grabbed me and talked about what had been going on all along.

"So suddenly the tunnel collapsed and my brother couldn't go to Chungmuro, Gaesin. Ugh, I thought I was really dying at that time-"

From tunnel collapse accidents to sudden scenario changes.

Even if I listened roughly, it sounded painful.

Because it's a round with so many variables. It was only a matter of luck that they survived.

I listened to Bang Cheolsoo's story and observed the people of Geumho Station looking this way from a distance.

The first thing that caught my eye was Dayoung and her daughter, who were called Moojung mother-daughter.

Dayoung's mother. In the third round, she struggles to save her daughter, but in the end she is the one who became the nutrient of Paradise.

"What is your overall ability level?"

"Don't tell me."

"You look lower than me."

Dayoung and Shin Yoosung were talking about their skills.

I looked back at Bang Cheolsoo, who was still talking.

"Brother, that’s why I sent them to-"

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' wants you to hang out with his incarnation again.]

I said, looking at the flag affixed to his waist.

"Bang Cheolsoo."

"Yes?"

"You've become a king."

"Ah."

Bang Cheolsoo, who opened his mouth slightly, scratched the back of his head and laughed shyly.

"Whoa, I'll give you the flag if you want. I had it for you anyway."

I looked down at the flag Bang Cheolsoo had outstretched.

It was lighter in color than mine, but it was a purple flag.

If I have that flag, I will achieve 'Black Flag' right away, then I can complete the 'King's Road' scenario and formally receive the 'King"s traits.

Of course, that was the easy way.

But.

"It's yours."

I didn't like it.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks why you don't accept it.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' nods to your judgment.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' admires your camaraderie.]

[500 coins were sponsored.]

I don't know why, but I didn't want to take that flag.

It might be because Dayoung, who is looking at Bang Cheolsoo from a distance with her mother, and other people's eyes.

I don't know.

Maybe it's a selfish wish as a writer.

The desire to see Bang Cheolsoo and the people's stories a little longer.

"Bro."

Bang Cheolsoo's eyes widened.

[The constellation 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is impressed by your spirit.]

[300 coins were sponsored.]

I said with a quick wave of my hand before the atmosphere got more serious.

"Rather than that, I'd like to hear something about the dungeon."

---

Thirty minutes after that, I stood at the entrance to the dungeon.

Do you want to enter the [Labyrinth]?

It was different from the dungeon in the main story, starting with the entry notification sound.

"If we go in here, there must be a star jewel, right?"

Bang Cheolsoo nodded his head at my question.

"Yes, sure. I also saw those who collected star jewels."

"They must be the 7 kings of Seoul."

"Oh, how did you know?"

It was obvious.

Even in the main story, only the 7 kings of Seoul were able to obtain the 'star jewels' here.

"No matter how strong my bro is, if you run into the 7 kings, you should avoid them. They really aren't normal guys."

"I guess so. Anyway, because they're kings."

This turn is the 41st, not the 3rd. It was seldom possible to know how high the level of the 7 kings would have been.

Still, I can't back down from here.

Whether it's the 7 kings or the Misreading association, if I can collect 'star jewels', then I should go in.

This is because the star jewel is an essential material for summoning the 'Sword of Death'.

"Brother, can't you really wait? In three hours, we can go back in."

"Three hours is too long. See you later."

Apparently, in this dungeon, once you exit, there is a waiting time for re-entry.

It would be nice to wait for the group at Geumho Station and enter together, but now was not the time to do that.

According to my thoughts, it is because the readers and Dansu ahjussi are definitely in that dungeon.

"I'm ready, ahjussi."

And fortunately. I wasn't even going alone.

"Are you really okay?"

"Yes. I'll go too."

Shin Yoosung said that and looked back at Dayoung, who was about ten steps away.

I saw Dayoung, who had opened her eyes, slashing her hand menacingly towards me.

"Dayoung, you can't do that."

When Dayoung's mother opened her mouth in a tone of admonition, Dayoung licked her lips. Shin Yoosung looked at Dayoung and continued.

"You have to become stronger, so you won’t be afraid even if you meet scary adults."

I wonder if she was stimulated by seeing a child her age. There was a certain determination in Shin Yoosung's voice.

It was a determination that somehow made me a little sad.

"There are also ways to meet good adults."

"Good adults die quickly."

As I was listening to those words that gave me a strange sense of déjà vu, a headache arose again deep inside my head.

I advised, rubbing my temples lightly.

"If it seems dangerous, we will escape immediately. You know?"

"Yes!"

It hurts my heart, but it was also true that Shin Yoosung's help was essential to clear the final chapter of the scenario.

Was Kim Dokja always with Shin Yoosung in this mood?

"Please be careful, brother!"

Leaving behind the group of Geumho Station, who bowed their heads in unison, I entered the labyrinth with Shin Yoosung.

[You have entered the 'Star Labyrinth'.]

As soon as I opened the door and entered, what I saw was a dark hallway reminiscent of a dungeon.

Fortunately, there seemed to be no 'new hunter' like before.

Just in case, I continued to be vigilant and looked around, but a series of system messages flew in.

[A new sub-scenario has arrived!]

**<Sub Scenario - Star Labyrinth>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: A++

Clear Condition: Explore the Star Labyrinth and acquire the hidden 'Star Jewel'

Time limit: —

Reward: 3,000 Coins

Failure: There is no failure penalty for this scenario.

* There are special rules for this scenario.

It's a star labyrinth.

I checked the 'Special Rules' that followed.

1. The Labyrinth Keeper appears in the Labyrinth.

Keeper?

Are there even minotaurs?

2. The labyrinth is relocated every 3 hours, and when relocated, the entire labyrinth is engulfed in flames and the internal structure is changed.

3. You can avoid the flames by entering the nearby 'Safe Area' when 'relocating'. You can choose to escape the labyrinth when entering the 'Safe Area'

Then, a timer appeared in front of my eyes.

[1 hour and 54 minutes left until relocation.]

[Look for a 'Safe Area'.]

Although this was tricky, the pattern itself wasn't difficult.

You can survive if you somehow find a 'safe area' within the time limit.

The question is, how many more of these rules are there?

> 4. 'Dust Man' is provided to all incarnations who have entered the Labyrinth.

Then a small lump of dust appeared in the air above my head.

The lump of dust with small eyes looked around, then opened its small mouth and made a sound.

—Byeolbyeol

As it was, it circled over my head and started to devour the shiny pieces of gold that were scattered on the floor.

[Your 'Dust Man' has acquired 1 Star Powder.]

Only then did I feel like I was getting a little bit of a sense of what the rules of this dungeon were.

"Wow, ahjussi! Look at this!"

Before I knew it, a small dust man had been created beside Shin Yoosung.

The dustman, who was circling around us with a 'byeolbyeol' sound, greedily opened his mouth whenever he saw gold dust glittering on the floor.

[Your 'Dust Man' has acquired 1 star dust!]

Seeing the scene, Shin Yoosung opened her mouth.

"I know what this is."

> 5. 'Dust Man' creates star jewels when acquiring a certain amount of 'star dust'.

Rules revealed as if they had been waiting.

As expected, the goal of this dungeon was to raise the 'Dust Man' and obtain the Star Jewels.

6. 'Dustmen' in the same group can be combined through [Fusion].

Shin Yoosung asked.

"Shall we put it together?"

"Great."

After all, we're in the same group.

There was no need to waste efficiency by raising several Dustmen.

When I selected [Fusion], my dust man opened his mouth wide and ate up Shin Yoosung's dust man.

[Incarnation Shin Yoosung's 'Dust Man' has been absorbed.]

[The 'Dust Man' of the Seoul Station Group is growing.]

Is it because they are combined? The speed at which he collected star dust was much faster than before.

"It keeps moving."

We continued to explore the labyrinth, calmly maintaining the boundaries of the sandbar.

Traces of a gruesome battle remained at every corner of the road.

The corpses stabbed and cut each other without hesitation, clinging to each other like stains.

Near the corpses, the star dust they had acquired during their lifetimes fell sparsely.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' says it's going to be fun now.]

[Some constellations are looking forward to your performance]

We picked up the star dust silently, as if we were collecting remains.

Why did these people have to come to this place and die?

Most of these people probably don't even know what the 'death sword' is.

[A small number of constellations hold their tongues.]

No, maybe I know why they died. They died to be a story.

"As expected, good adults die quickly."

When I looked around, Shin Yoosung was staring down at the dead woman's face.

I also stopped beside Shin Yoosung and looked down at the dead woman.

An unfamiliar face.

I don't know who this person is.

I probably won't know in the future.

But Shin Yoosung seemed to know.

"Do you know this person?"

"She's the one who stopped me when I tried to enter the single-person dungeon."

I put my hand on the shoulder of Shin Yoosung, who was standing blankly.

"Shin Yoosung."

"Yes."

"Are you okay?"

After hesitating for a while, Shin Yoosung nodded her head.

I couldn't read the child's expression, so I couldn't tell if she was okay or not. But at that moment, Shin Yoosung's retina looked strangely deep.

"People always died even before the scenario."

"That's true."

"It just didn't happen right in front of me."

I didn't expect to hear such a story, so I was a little surprised.

Shin Yoosung quickly shook her head.

"Sorry. I said something too cheeky. Sometimes I say strange things without even realizing it."

"No. I also agree with you. Death has always existed. It's just that it wasn't so explicit."

People died even before the scenarios started.

Men killed men.

They killed each other and talked about each other's death. It's a world where it's okay to talk like that.

"Are you all right?"

"I'm fine."

Since it was a world where all gods could exist as 'constellations', there was nothing strange about killing people.

However, in a world like that, I rather didn't want to believe in anything.

"Do people have souls?"

"They do."

Was it because I answered too confidently? Shin Yoosung asked with her eyes wide open.

"Then where will the dead Younghoon go?"

"She will go to the underworld."

"Are there scenarios there?"

"There might be."

"Then, even if I die, it won't be any different from here."

"In a sense."

Then Shin Yoosung looked up at me.

"Still, ahjussi, don't die."

I nodded.

"Shin Yoosung as well."

We prayed for the woman's rest in silence. The ashes scattered on the floor looked like the scattered soul of a woman.

[Dust Man's 'star dust' has exceeded 100!]

[Only in the Star Labyrinth, your physical strength will increase by 1.]

Even in the midst of that, we were getting stronger at the cost of surviving.

I ran into other incarnations several times, but as soon as they saw my 'Blade of Faith', they got scared and ran away.

Somehow, it was a day when I didn't want to kill anyone, so I thought it was fortunate in my heart.

[Star dust obtained so far: 302]

Shin Yoosung said while looking at the star dust that had already exceeded 300.

"Ahjussi, if it's like this-"

"Don't say it will go smoothly."

"Yes?"

It was then that the empty Dustman stopped.

-Star?

[Currently, there is almost no 'star dust' remaining in the 'Star Labyrinth'.]

Damn, then it is.

There's no way the 'scenario I knew' would go so smoothly.

[Hunt other incarnations to obtain 'star dust'.]

After all, this labyrinth is a stage created to induce the incarnations to fight.

How many incarnations must I hunt to collect seven star jewels?

I didn't want to guess.

It was then that the additional rules came to mind.

> 7. Incarnations that have acquired 'Star Jewels' will have their overall stats rise dramatically.
>
> 8. Every time you acquire 1 'Star Jewel', the 'Madness' level increases.

…Madness?

—Star!

Suddenly, the Dust Man above my head started shaking like crazy.

The reason was immediately clear.

[There is an incarnation with a star jewel nearby.]

"Ahjussi."

I nodded.

A slight vibration was felt on the floor.

Something was coming this way.

"There is one of the 'Seven Kings of Seoul' around here."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 654 Episode 19 People of the Past (6)

With Shin Yoosung, I held my breath and hid between the underground passages.

Then, a group of people jumped out from the opposite street corner.

"This way!"

Did they notice us?

Looking at the movement, there is a feeling that they are intentionally directed this way, but the target is us.

I used 'group chat' with Shin Yoosung.

—Shin Yoosung. You should run away immediately.

I felt that no matter what happened, I had to save this child.

If Shin Yoosung dies here, the 41st round will end with the worst ending I can think of.

—If ahjussi runs away too.

A formidable answer came back.

I hesitated to answer, but Shin Yoosung sent another message.

—But maybe we can win?

—It could be.

Maybe it's because of 'Beast Lord? Shin Yoo-seung seemed to be able to know the talents of incarnations just by looking at them.

[Story, 'the tenacious Murim master' shudders.]

The number and skill of the running enemies were excellent. It is only natural that they are the elite of the 7 kings of Seoul.

But do you think I will lose? If you ask me, I wouldn't.

Does that mean I've become stronger?

At first glance, I thought that I was stronger than Kim Dokja of the same period, but I hadn't had a chance to properly check my skills in the meantime.

However, it wasn't just that we were talking about the enemies.

—Those two over there are strong.

I could feel it too.

Two extraordinary auras were felt among them.

"Gu Taesung! This way! Move!"

Gu Taesung.

One of the 7 kings of Seoul. A person who has Gyeonwon, the king of Later Baekje, as his background.

He was a man called 'The Dragon King'.

Next to him was an incarnation wearing a black night suit, but I couldn't guess who it was just by looking at his face.

"Assassin King. What's the target?"

"Now it's intelligent."

Assassin King.

At the entrance to the dungeon, the assassins who tried to harm us told us this name.

Somehow, that man in the night suit seemed to be the leader of the rookie hunters.

[The exclusive skill 'reader comment list' is activated!]

[This reader took an abnormal path .]

['Omniscient reader's viewpoint was used.]

A message I've seen before.

It was the same case as the text book writer I met in the 'Theatre Dungeon'.

「It's the Misreading association.」

Those who possessed characters here after illegally reading the novel.

From what I could see, both Gu Taesung, the Dragon King, and the Assassin King were all on that side.

—big star.

The Dustman's reaction also changed.

It probably means that the two of them have a 'star jewel'. Shin Yoosung, who was by my side, turned to the Dustman, placing her finger on her lips as if telling him to be quiet.

—Ahjussi, what should I do?

—Let's observe the situation for a moment.

Bang Cheolsoo's warning came to mind.

「"Brother, if you meet the 7 kings of Seoul, you must avoid them unconditionally."」

Until now, I thought so. It was important to collect star jewels, but I had no intention of taking unnecessary risks with Shin Yoosung.

However.

「Isn't that worth fighting for?」

When I asked why that thought came to my mind, I was comparing them to someone without realizing it.

[The constellation 'The Last Ark' laughs.]

Come to think of it, the king of beggars I faced at Seoul Station was the body of a constellation.

No matter how strong the 7 kings of Seoul are, they are only the incarnations of a great constellation.

In a sense, I've already had a record of dealing with a first-class incarnation.

I was thinking about whether to attack now, but I decided to eavesdrop on their conversation.

"What about troop losses?"

"There were a few minor injuries, but no fatalities."

"No fatalities?"

Intermittent murmurings could be heard from a distance.

It was a vibration I had heard before.

"Did you not hear? He said he doesn't kill anyone."

"He’s not killing anyone."

"There are rumors that they are members of the apostle side."

Apostle?

"I don't like their hypocrisy. It's just like them and us who read a damn novel anyway."

"That's true. What's the point of spending a few hundred won on that?"

I resisted the urge to go right away and slap him in the back of the head.

By the way, are you insane for talking about things like that?

[A few constellations protest why there are so many filtered conversations these days.]

It's a conversation that is filtered anyway, so they don't have any intention of hiding it.

"What happened to the possessed constellation? Have you been contacted?"

"No. Not yet. It looks like it's been a bit of time."

"You damn bastards. Then why mess with the Goryeo's First Sword?"

"They don't even know the contents of their novels. We should have done the constellation possession."

As the vibration that resonated with the labyrinth approached, the two men shut their mouths at the same time.

"It’s coming."

The faces of the two people had a strange tension. Then came the sound of flesh being torn from the aisle and an horrible scream.

Then, with the sound of gasping for breath, incarnations appeared. An incarnation with one arm ripped off. An incarnation with a broken shin. The incarnations who lost all their weapons ran this way in a hurry.

Even seeing the injured men, the two did not look too surprised.

As if they had foreseen this situation.

"Is that what happens when you collect three star jewels?"

"If you're jealous, I'll hand over my star jewel to you."

"I decline."

A gigantic figure swayed behind the avatars.

At first glance, a gigantic creature that appears to be twice the size of an ordinary incarnation.

Could that be the Labyrinth Keeper?

The Dustman, who was spinning around, couldn't control himself and shivered.

—Big star!

Not a Labyrinth Keeper.

In other words, that monster is also an 'incarnation' like us.

However, was there such an incarnation in Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint?

Shin Yoosung, who was next to me, was also holding on to my sleeve, as if surprised.

A slight tremor passed through the child's fingertips.

"That can't be won."

The hairs on the backs of my hands were warning me.

I couldn't see the form properly yet, but the giant in the darkness was stronger than Gu Taesung and the assassin king combined.

Who the hell is it?

At this point, if it is an existence with a level of combat power that exceeds the '7 kings of Seoul'.

"Light!"

Along with Gu Taesung's cry, someone lit a light in the darkness of the underground passage.

The giant's face was revealed to the whole world.

Arms filled with strong muscles.

Empty pupils as if he had lost his mind. Lips moving repeatedly as if chanting Buddhist prayers.

"I will not kill you. I won't kill you."

The moment I heard the voice, I got goosebumps.

—Ahjussi?

I forgot to reply to Shin Yoosung and ran out.

"Wow! What is it?"

One of the incarnations that spotted me jumping through the aisle brandished a blind knife.

After receiving the blade as it was, I tripped the incarnation.

The incarnation let out a small scream and fell down on the back of his head before making a pack sound.

Did he die? I don't know.

However, now was not the time to be immersed in sentimentality.

I was looking at a giant.

"Looking for someone. I'm looking for someone."

Why is that person here?

I could see her man's thick hand poking through the air.

It was a different size, but it was a hand I knew well.

The person who asked me where the bugs were. With that hand, he found the bug under the vending machine.

"Find someone."

It felt like a part of my chest was about to collapse.

The first reader I met after possessing someone in this world.

A man who was brought into this world for reading a novel his daughter was reading.

"Noh Jiyoon. Noh Jiyoon."

Jiyoon's father.

"Dansu ahjussi!"

However, as if he couldn't hear my voice, he only repeated vain gestures toward the air.

If you look closely, you can see that the old man's eyes are black.

My breath choked, and deep anger and sorrow rushed at once.

What the hell happened in the meantime?

Why did Ahjussi become like that?

What the hell kind of people made you like that?

Could it be because of the life that flowed out in an instant? A group of incarnations looked back at my width.

I could see Gu Taesung and the Assassin King frowning at me.

I saw them face to face.

Are these guys the ones who made you that way?

"Are you a hindrance?"

The assassin king who found me muttered in a calm voice.

At the same time, the sound of flesh breaking was heard from the front of the aisle.

[The incarnation 'Dansu' has currently acquired 3 Star Jewels.]

Every time Dansu Ahjussi swung his giant hand. The incarnations were helplessly swept away.

"I'm sorry. I'm sorry."

The incarnations who were hit by ahjussi were injured, but did not die. Moderate to minor injuries that do not end life.

"I won't kill you. I won't kill you."

Come to think of it, Dansu ahjussi was like that from the first scenario.

The man who killed a bug in the first scenario has never killed a person.

「"It's just because I'm weak."」

That's what he said, but I knew why the old man didn't really kill people.

A man who is always looking for his daughter.

There is only one reason why such a man does not kill people.

「"I want Jiyoon to be proud of me."」

"Dansu ahjussi! Calm down!"

He looked around as if he still couldn't hear me.

One of the incarnations that had been paying attention suddenly attacked me from behind. However, the incarnation was struck in the neck by a dagger flying from the side and fell down.

"Ahjussi."

It was Shin Yoosung. I nodded and looked around at the incarnations around me. No matter how I look at it, these guys are the ones who are aiming for Dansu ahjussi, so it was urgent to deal with these guys first.

It was then that Gu Taesung, who was checking his watch, raised his head.

"I think you misunderstood. We don't intend to fight."

You don't want to fight?

The guy looked back at the members of his group who had fallen to me and Shin Yoosung, then clicked his tongue and said.

"You don't know what's going on right now?"

"Old Taesung. Don't talk nonsense."

Despite the Assassin King's warning, Gu Taesung looked at my width and continued.

"Looks like you're on the edge. Let me give you a piece of advice. You'd better get away from here quickly. Or you'll get run over by that monster too."

"Gu Taesung. He's here."

With those words, Gu Taesung and the Assassin King moved. I nervously grabbed the hilt of my sword. If I had to, I was thinking of cutting the backs of the kings to save ahjussi.

However.

"Just throw food and it will fall."

Instead of grabbing weapons, Gu Taesung and the Assassin King reached out for their own Dustmen.

—Light up.

Two shining white jewels protruded from the little Dustman's mouth.

It must have been. It was the 'Star Jewel' that we had been looking for all along.

It was the continued actions of the guys that made it happen.

"Eat it, you bastard!"

They threw their star jewels at Dansu ahjussi.

"I'm sorry. I'm sorry."

A star jewel flew towards the man who was repeating his apology into the air. After that, the Dustman, who was flying near ahjussi, opened his mouth wide.

[Incarnation 'Lee Dansu' gets 2 additional 'Star Jewels'!]

At the same time, cracks began to appear all over ahjussi’s body.

With a crackling sound, ahjussi’s muscles were torn and swollen.

The Assassin King let out an unpleasant laugh.

"It's a success."

"Now just feed two more and we’re done. Everyone withdraw!"

The Assassin King and Gu Taesung's group seemed to have finished their mission and didn't look back.

I heard it everywhere in the labyrinth.

As if, from the beginning, they had no intention of hunting him.

I couldn't understand what the hell was going on.

I sorted out the situation in the confusion.

One, Dansu ahjussi already had three star jewels.

If I were to simply summarize the situation that was happening right in front of my eyes, that would be it.

"They gave the star jewel to Dansu ahjussi on purpose."

Why? He already had three star jewels.

If he gets two more star jewels in that situation, the old man will only become ridiculously strong.

"By the way, was that all?"

Belatedly, the rules of this dungeon came to mind.

> 8. Every time you acquire 1 'Star Jewel', the 'Madness' level increases.

No way.

I approached Dansu ahjussi who was kneeling.

"Ahjussi! It's me! Ahjussi!"

Dansu ahjussi, who had grown even bigger than before, had now grown to the point of being reminiscent of a small giant.

I could feel his presence just by getting close.

As if reminiscent of Yoo Joonghyuk, a sense of heavy pressure that chokes your breath.

To the old man who was crying and scratching the floor as if in pain, I stretched out my hands and shouted.

"Me, Cheon Inho! Take a seat!"

At the word Cheon Inho, the man raised his head. For an instant, hope welled up.

Does he recognize me?

Ahjussi’s lips were saying something.

Jiyoon.

The next moment, ahjussi’s huge palm flew towards me. It was a relentless blow with no chance to escape. If Shin Yoosung hadn't pulled my back just in time, I might have been crushed by it.

I looked down at the floor where Dansu ahjussi’s palm had been planted. The floor was severely cracked with the palm at the center.

Cold sweat ran down my back.

I was about to die. Really, I almost died.

Shin Yoosung, holding onto my sleeve, was shouting something, but I could only hear what ahjussi said.

"I'm sorry. I'm sorry."

A man who repeats an apology. The man who had lost both eyes looked at me with wide open pupils.

[Incarnation 'Lee Dansu' has fallen into 'Madness Level 5'.]

Madness level 5.

| |
|---|
| 9. Every time the 'Madness' stage goes up, the overall ability increases greatly and you lose your sanity. |

Only then did I understand why the 7 kings abandoned the star jewels and fled.

The tenth rule came to mind soon after.

| |
|---|
| 10. If someone collects 7 Star Jewels, the Death Sword will be summoned. |

Goosebumps ran down my spine.

「The goal of this place was not to collect 7 jewels.」

The 'star jewels' in this dungeon were a trap.

'Star Jewels' that made one lose their reason in return for gaining strong power.

In other words, in order to properly collect 'star jewels', you should never collect 'star jewels'.

Therefore, the goal of this dungeon was as follows.

「To make someone other than yourself collect '7 star jewels'.」

Dansu ahjussi, who became a monster, slowly got up and started walking towards me.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 655 Episode 19 People of the Past (7)

"Ahjussi. Run away. Hurry."

Shin Yoosung urgently pulled my sleeve. The child's eyes blinked intermittently with a golden light.

"Quickly!"

Today's Dansu ahjussi is dangerous.

"I will not kill you. I won't kill you."

[The story 'Relentless Murim Master' warns you.]

The spirit of the Murim people was warning me. If I deal with Dansu ahjussi now, I will die.

"Ahjussi! Wake up! Please!"

He did not respond at all to my calls. He just came towards us step by step, with heavy steps.

"I'm sorry. I'm sorry."

Dansu ahjussi wasn't looking at me. In the place where ahjussi's eyes had been, only pitch-black darkness swayed emptily.

[Someone activated the 'trap switch'.]

[The dungeon rearrangement time will be readjusted.]

[Dungeon relocation will begin in 10 minutes.]

To make matters worse, the relocation time was advanced.

Maybe it was the work of the 7 kings of Seoul who ran away earlier.

[After a while, the entire dungeon will be engulfed in flames.]

[Find the 'Safe Zone'.]

The dungeon floor vibrated lightly, and I felt faint heat at my ankles. If 5 more minutes pass like this, the whole area will be covered with a hot fire.

When I thought so, my mind went dark.

Let's assume Shin Yoosung and I manage to escape. Then, what happens to the Dansu ahjussi?

[Participants with Star Jewels are immune from the flames caused by 'Rearrangement'.]

A sigh of relief came out.

Now, Dansu ahjussi has absorbed five star jewels.

At least this relocation will not change the life or death of ahjussi.

—Ahjussi.

Shin Yoosung shook me once again.

I had to make a decision.

"Dansu ahjussi. I'll be back soon."

"Looking for someone."

Now things have changed.

It is said that he is immune from the flames, but Shin Yoosung and I were not.

Still unable to hear me, Dansu ahjussi pursed his lips.

"Jiyoon."

"Yes. We decided to find Jiyoon."

Jiyoon. Ahjussi steps slowed down for an instant.

I continued to speak with clenched fists.

"I told you I would definitely find her. Do you remember?"

Dansu ahjussi, who had been hesitant, moved his head very slowly. I couldn't tell if that meant he understood what I was saying or if it was just a coincidence.

I suppressed my surging heart and grabbed Shin Yoosung's hand.

"I'll definitely be back."

I just started running.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' mourns the tragedy of the incarnation Lee Dansu.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' laments the cruelty of the scenario.]

[Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' wipes his head.]

I will never let you die like this.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' supports your fight.]

Dansu ahjussi didn't come after us.

[After 8 minutes 'Rearrangement' will begin.]

We immediately set out to search for a safe area. To save Dansu ahjussi, we must first survive.

Shin Yoosong, who was looking at the left and right aisles with me, opened her mouth.

"Ahjussi."

"Yes."

"Is that person close to you?"

Without a moment to think, my mouth answered first.

"Yes."

I also let go.

Close person.

That's what I was thinking of Dansu ahjussi.

For a moment, a weak spark flowed from Shin Yoosung's body. I looked back in amazement.

Shin Yoosung avoided my gaze and lowered her head.

"I see..."

Shin Yoosung's eyes briefly shimmered in gold.

What are these gold eyes?

Did Shin Yoosung in the main story have such an ability?

I couldn't remember it well. As far as I know, the gold eyes are a characteristic of Yoo Joonghyuk, who has [Sage's Eyes].

Come to think of it, where is Yoo Joonghyuk now? It was time for him to save Yoo Mia and return to Gwanghwamun, but there was no news yet.

['Rearrangement' will begin after 7 minutes.]

Damn, now is not the time to think about Yoo Joonghyuk.

Little by little, my mind was quickened. If I stayed like this, I was going to die before I could meet Yoo Joonghyuk again.

However, no matter how much I searched, I couldn't find a 'safe area'.

In 'Ways of Survival', it was written to take an incarnation with the [Guide] attribute or the [Find the maze] skill in preparation for such a situation.

But neither I nor Shin Yoosung had those characteristics or skills.

['Rearrangement' will begin in 6 minutes.]

I quickly checked the stardust we had.

[Star dust obtained so far: 314]

If you get a 'star jewel', you can endure the hellfire of 'rearrangement'.

If I collect additional star dust and make a star jewel, at least Shin Yoosung might be able to be saved.

The problem is that there is only one way to quickly obtain dust powder.

[The other incarnations must be killed.]

[After 5 minutes 'Relocation' will start.]

It was then that Shin Yoosung's voice was heard.

"Ahjussi. Over there."

About ten paces ahead, from the inside of the aisle on the right, a faint stream of light was pouring out.

We ran straight to the corner of the road where the light came out.

[A safe area has been found.]

Fortunately, there was a safe area left.

However, there were those who occupied the 'safe area' before us.

"Oh, we met again."

A troubled voice.

It was Gu Taesung, one of the 7 kings of Seoul, whom I had met earlier.

"I'm sorry, but there aren't enough seats here. Find another place."

Gu Taesung was in a safe area with two of his subordinates.

A green circle in the size of 1 pyeong, reminiscent of the 'Green Zone of Chungmuro'.

At the top of the circle, the currently accessible places were marked.

[Available capacity: 3/4]

One place left.

There are five people in total, including us.

It was then that Gu Taesung's eyes changed.

"Hmm? Hold on."

His eyes were looking at Shin Yoosung. When I reflexively hid Shin Yoosung behind my back, he moved his lips slightly and started talking to someone in a 'group chat'. Then he asked with a smile on his face.

"What's that kid's name?"

Did he know Shin Yoosung?

"I have no obligation to inform you."

Then, Gu Taesung smiled.

"I don't think it's a situation to be so bold, right?

[After 4 minutes 'Relocating' will begin.]

4 minutes left.

Gu Taesung opened his mouth first, as if he had made up his mind on something.

"I will take the child."

For a moment, my head went blank.

Where did I hear that line?

Gu Taesung chuckled and looked back at his subordinates.

"Didn't I just act like Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"Yoo Joonghyuk? Are you talking about the king?"

"No. What do you guys know?"

Gu Taesung, slightly frowning, looked back at me. A completely different look from before.

"Kill him. And bring the kid."

As if he had waited, each of his subordinates handed over a sword and a spear.

I looked at the dangerously approaching guys for a while and asked.

"Did you guys make Dansu ahjussi like that?"

At my question, the subordinates turned to each other.

"Dansu ahjussi? Who is he talking about?"

"Isn’t he talking about the old man who was talking about his daughter?"

"Ah, you mean the sacrifice."

Sacrifice.

"Well, we did feed him star jewels. It's honestly not our fault. We only gave it to him because he wanted a star jewel, right?"

"That's right. Anyway, if a person has a lot of greed—"

The moment I heard the voice full of ridicule, I felt something cut off inside me.

The [Blade of Faith] is activated!

"What is that?"

The radiance of conviction that illuminates the darkness.

Gu Taesung seemed to have noticed what this item was.

"No way…"

I swung my sword without hesitation. Surprised, the subordinates swung their swords at me.

[Story, 'The Tenacious Murim Master' stutters.]

However, to me who has the legend of the ark of the dragon, their trajectory was as easy to avoid as a child's toy knife.

The blue, white and blue sword cut through the air. With the sound of the cross section being neatly cut, the two men fell to the floor without even leaving a final word.

However, thanks to his subordinates buying a moment, Gu Taesung seemed to have finished his preparations.

[Incarnation 'Gu Taesung' activates 'Weapon Improvement Lv.4'.]

[Incarnation 'Gu Taesung' activates 'Advanced Swordsmanship Lv.3'!]

[Incarnation 'Gu Taesung activates the characteristic effect!]

['King's Spirit' effect activates!]

Gu Taesung's sponsor is 'the founding of Hannam-gun'.

In other words, he is the incarnation of Gyeonhun, the king of later Baekje.

However, despite the pouring skill activation message, I was calm.

「I didn’t feel like I was going to lose at all.」

"How do you have Broken Faith?"

"I picked it up."

"What?"

I immediately started pushing him. The batting stick of the Dragon Head Ark unfolds through 'Broken Faith', and in the magic of 'Circulation Delay' [Baekjeong Ganggi], I launched a wave of attacks.

Gu Taesung, who had been taking backward steps in succession, spat out an astonishment.

"Who are you? How can you be like this…"

He might be surprised.

Because there's no one like me among the characters he knows.

[Incarnation 'Gu Taesung' activates 'Relentless Guts Lv.3'!]

But surely the 7 kings are the 7 kings.

As the battle lengthened, he was following my movements little by little.

It was because of his skill, [Relentless Guts].

The longer the battle drags on, the worse it gets for me. In the end, I too have to throw the odds.

"I heard you were imitating Yoo Joonghyuk earlier."

"What?"

[The sub-skill, 'Enhance Sentence' is activated!]

[You can enter your actions.]

[The action you enter is 'reinforced'.]

[The current enhancement level is level 1.]

I entered the sentence without hesitation.

「Cheon Inho used 'Incite'.」

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite' is enhanced!]

[Incite is temporarily awakened.]

[You can incite yourself to imitate any character you want!]

I remembered 'Yoo Joonghyuk' in the 3rd round that Kim Dokja met.

The strong and ruthless king of the 3rd round.

I know.

Now, I will not be able to absorb the skills of Yoo Joonghyuk, but 'Omniscient Reader' is a very long novel, and among them, there will be a Yoo Joonghyuk that I can imitate.

「Finally, the sleeping prince has awakened from a deep sleep.」

Gu Taesung gave orders, probably feeling something out of the ordinary.

"It's here! Everyone come this way! Kill this guy!"

At the same time as he said that, more than a dozen incarnations appeared from the back of the aisle.

All of them were subordinates of Gu Taesung.

Apparently, they were the ones who called over the group chat earlier.

Gu Taesung's lips seemed to be filled with a smile once again.

Seeing that guy, I opened my mouth.

"I am."

A sword of old age falling over his head.

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk from the 3rd round, who cut down the apostle."

The moment Gu Taesung opened his eyes in surprise, a faint spark flowed through my body.

Goosebumps ran down my spine, and my sense of time and space slowed down.

「Uncomfortable feeling, like wearing ill-fitting clothes. The height of the line of sight that is subtly different from usual, and the five different senses.」

This is Yoo Joonghyuk's view.

I could feel my muscles contracting strongly. A power beyond the limits of my body was stirring within me.

[Incite activates!]

Only the 3rd round.

It was also Yoo Joonghyuk, who had a lower overall ability than me in the early days and now, but it was so difficult to imitate him.

「"Don't rest and move."」

The voice of the pajeon swordsman echoed in my head.

「"Is a guy who wants to acquire the Fiery Sword of the Underworld broken down from just that much?"」

Perhaps this is Yoo Joonghyuk's memory.

「"Fifty years, if not ten years. If you can't do it in 50 years, work hard with the spirit that you will cut it in 100 years. Build up over the years. Engrave in your body and mind the memories that no star can destroy you."」

Maybe it was natural.

Even if it was only the third round, Yoo Joonghyuk lived an overwhelming time that was incomparable to me.

He is the incarnation of the highest peak who has already risen to the Transcendental Seat in the second round.

He was a being who had trained for a hundred years in 'Time Fault' .

Blood gushed out of my nose with the sound of a push shot. It was as if a book's worth of type had been crumpled into a sheet of A4 paper, and it felt like my brain, unable to withstand the pressure, would explode.

But I persevered.

I know that it is impossible to truly become that 'Yoo Joonghyuk'. But.

「At that moment, 'I' realized who I was.」

At least for a moment.

「My hand grasps the hilt as if doing something that has been repeated a million times over. The feeling of the fingers wrapped around the grip was unfamiliar.」

If it is 'Yoo Joonghyuk' in a single moment when he killed the apostles in Chungmuro.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Murderous intent and anger welled up in my head. Resentment towards the people behind and hatred towards the constellations.

The dead comrades.

The world that was abandoned by Yoo Joonghyuk and could not be saved was entangling my entire body like a chain.

This is the curse of the regressor.

Yoo Joonghyuk has always lived through these things.

I could feel Shin Yoosung's gaze from behind.

I said without looking back.

—Get down, Shin Yoosung.

Shin Yoosung reflexively lowered her waist and my sword moved at the same time.

[The constellation 'Hannam County Founder' shouts to avoid!]

There is no way to avoid this sword.

「One step was so natural, even beautiful.」

Because it was the most perfect swordsman Kim Dokja knew.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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「The silent blade moved, and no one could see it.」

The extremely compressed sense of time slowly returned, and a light spark flew from the right hand holding the sword.

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier is looking at you.]

I couldn't hear the screams of the incarnations or the sound of weapons clashing anymore.

All the signs that were running towards me also disappeared.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' opens his mouth.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' says, that the incarnation Cheon Inho is actually hiding his power, and his eyes light up.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' feels deep sadness from your sword.]

While the sound of something falling on the floor echoed one after another, no one shared the same eye level as me.

I was alone.

Probably like Yoo Joonghyuk always did.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' is amazed at your martial arts.]

[The constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword'...]

[A handful of constellations sponsored 1,000 coins for your action.]

A sense of limitless omnipotence and superiority dwelling in the body.

This was Yoo Joonghyuk.

For a moment, I felt someone in the distant sky watching me.

[A constellation wrapped in a veil slows down.]

When I suddenly raised my head at the unfamiliar hostility, my eyes disappeared somewhere.

A tingling feeling of fatigue.

I have already experienced the side effects of [Incite] through [Sentence Reinforcement].

If I procrastinate here any longer, I'll be eaten up by [Incite] like last time.

Tsutsutsutsut.

['Incite' is canceled.]

A terrifying recoil rushed through my body. Blood trickled down from my mouth.

It was a really grueling experience. It's just the weight of Yoo Joonghyuk in the very beginning, and that's a momentary [incite].

Even if it was, is it this much?

Even after the skill was unlocked, I felt something like Yoo Joonghyuk’s remnant in my head.

It was a joke.

I lightly wiped my lips with one hand and looked down at the floor.

"Uh. Aaaaaaaa!"

A scream that rang out a beat late.

Gu Taesung was lucky. The legs of the guy were rolling on the floor. Stopping the pouring blood, he was looking up at me with red eyes.

The emotion in his eyes quickly turned to fear.

Gu Taesung, perhaps forgetting the pain, began to servilely pray.

"Save me! Save me!"

I approached the guy.

Looking at his terrified face reminded me of Dansu ahjussi's face. Dansu ahjussi, who had blank eyes.

Gu Taesung was full of wounds, and a man who lost his mind was looking for his daughter.

"It's all because of Dansu ahjussi."

They made Dansu ahjussi that way. They ruined the life of an innocent ahjussi who was searching for his daughter in this world.

「They must be killed.」

The remnants of Yoo Joonghyuk inside of me were saying that.

"Ho, are you by any chance a reader?"

Gu Taesung suddenly lifted his head and said while holding onto my trousers.

"Save me. Please, please save me! We're from the same world."

The moment I saw the trembling face looking up at me, I realized who this man was.

This man is not 'old-fashioned'.

"I am also a person who has read 'The Book of Revelation'. I really enjoyed it."

"…"

"It's all a misunderstanding... It's a misunderstanding! I'm different from the others! I didn't read all of them illegally, and I paid for a lot of them!"

Like a condemned prisoner confessing his sins for the last time before he dies, he continued to talk.

"I want to live. I want to live. Please. I want to go back home. I didn't want to come to a place like this."

As he said that, he shed tears as if he was overwhelmed.

"Uh, I miss Mom and Dad. Fuck. I didn't want to do this either. Just, just to survive somehow..."

How old was this man?

Where did he live and what did he do?

I do not know. Then and now, this man was a complete stranger to me.

「So maybe, this is the last chance to kill this man.」

The moment I make up my mind and fixed 'Broken Faith' again.

"I will do it."

Shin Yoosung passed me by and said.

"I have to practice too."

Practice.

"To survive."

Shin Yoosung's voice was low when she said that. I couldn't see the child's expression, but I could see why.

Shin Yoosung's eyes would be golden now.

"You don't want to do that, ahjussi."

Is it small? Shin Yoosung's small back as she spat those words made me feel the years I did not know. She must have been a child who had only lived for ten years.

I grabbed Shin Yoosung's shoulder.

"I'll do it."

In the meantime, Gu Taesung dragged his butt and retreated to the edge. But he had nowhere to run.

['Relocate' will begin in 1 minute.]

If he gets out of this 'safe area' anyway, he will be burned to death.

Gu Taesung, perhaps realizing his situation, began to pray again.

"Please help me. I really didn't want to do this either. They said that if I just performed my role well, I would be sent home."

"What do you mean by that?"

The one possessed by Gu Taesung was a member of the 'Misreading association'.

But I don't know how the 'Misreading association' came to this world.

They were not readers who purchased and read the entire book, nor were they participants in 'Kim Dokja's Banquet'.

Then, how did they possess this world?

Gu Taesung swallowed his breath at the sharpness of the blade pressing down on his throat.

"Who brought you here?"

"That, that's…"

Gu Taesung opened his mouth again, as if he had made up his mind on something.

"Kim Dok—"

Tsutsutsutsutsutsutsutsu!

Suddenly, his whole body jumped up like an electrocuted fish. The boy's lips were on fire.

Something was controlling the guy's right to speak.

['Relocate' will begin in 30 seconds.]

Gu Taesung, who twisted his body as if in pain, managed to part his lips.

"I'm sorry. I can't tell you that. I'll do anything else instead. Anything I can—"

I looked down at such a man, and the remnants of the Yoo Joonghyuk that remained in my head did not speak to me anymore. Maybe it was because my heart was a little weak, but what came to my mind instead was the memory of Dansu ahjussi.

「"No matter how much it is in a novel, I don't want to kill anyone."」

After the scenarios started, ahjussi hadn't killed anyone until now. Even now, when he lost his reason and became a monster, he kept repeating the words "I won't kill you".

Obviously, the fragment of Kim Dokja inside ahjussi must be the best and purest piece of Kim Dokja.

「"Because it's a novel that my daughter liked."」

I slowly lowered the sword that I was raising.

[After 20 seconds, 'Rearrangement' will begin.]

Gu Taesung's complexion brightened.

"Thank you! Thank you!" Gu Taesung shed tears of relief and put his hand on his chest.

"I-I don't have much, but even this-"

The moment I tried to say I didn't need it, I felt my bones soften.

Something was approaching at great speed.

Shin Yoosung caught me as if she felt something strange, and I also covered Shin Yoosung as if to protect her.

The magic wave that flew in with a squeaking sound.

I reflexively grasped 'Broken Faith'.

[Broken Faith's durability has run out.]

In an instant, I realized something.

「This is not an attack aimed at us.」

The magic wave passed me and Shin Yoosung, and blew Gu Taesung's neck.

It was a tragedy that took place without a chance to stop it.

The magic, that came into the safe area in an instant, turned Gu Taesung's hair into a green circle.

"It’s still backing down." A familiar voice said.

A man in a black coat was there.

Quite a handsome face for an extra.

A unique way of speaking that imitates Yoo Joonghyuk.

The king of kings doesn't act that way. What's the point of worrying about killing the wicked?

I saw a woman standing next to him as if in trouble, nodding at me.

I remembered the last conversation I had with her.

There was a calm turmoil in my heart.

[Safe area is activated]

[Entrance capacity: 4/4]

['Relocation' begins.]

The apostle siblings.

The 2nd Apostle Killer King and Literature Girl 64 participated in the War of the Absolute Throne.

---

The relocation lasted exactly one minute or so.

As the raging fire burned everything in the 'safe zone', the maze moved and the composition of the passage changed.

As soon as the relocation was over, Killer King found the body of Gu Taesung, who was rolling nearby.

"Look. This guy had other plans."

In Killer King's hand, there was a 'poison bomb'

I remembered the expression on the face of Gu Taesung as he put his hand in the customs for the last time.

Was it really a bomb that Gu Taesung was trying to take out?

Killer King added, as if he had read my expression.

"Don't feel guilty. Just think that a person you don't know is dead. You don't grieve over someone dying on the other side of the globe."

Clearly he was a stranger to me. I don't know his name, his face, or where he lives.

"They used anonymity to commit crimes. No need to sympathize."

Is it really a problem that can be overcome?

What would you say if you were Dansu ahjussi?

I pursed my lips in search of words several times, but I did not know what to say.

Perhaps, it's because I don't have a fragment of the real Kim Dokja'.

"Have you been doing anything in the meantime?"

Instead of talking about strangers, I decided to talk about people I knew.

"Hmm."

Killer King, who picked up the items in Gu Taesung's arms, stood up.

A flag was tied to his forearm like an armband.

Black flag.

As expected, Killer King has completed all of the 'King's Way' scenarios.

It was natural.

He is the second apostle who has read the 'Omniscient Reader' over a hundred times and his sponsor is the archangel Jophiel.

"It was a lot of work."

As expected, Killer King, who checked my flag, was looking at Shin Yoosung.

"Looks like there's been a lot going on there too."

We briefly shared what had happened so far.

Things after clearing the theater dungeon and being scattered in Chungmuro.

There were places I didn't know about at all along Killer King's route, and there were hidden pieces that I hadn't even thought of.

I also briefly described the events that had occurred.

Things from going to Seoul Station to meeting the Beggar Sect, coming to Gwanghwamun and entering the dungeon.

When I finally brought up the story of Dansu ahjussi, Killer King let out a short sigh.

"If it's Dansu, you mean the old man who was looking for his daughter."

"You're right."

“It's difficult. The scenario is very different from the original."

"..."

"In order to obtain the death sword, seven star jewels are required. But if the man has five…"

When he brought up the story, I wondered if I done anything wrong.

It reminded me of Killer King who killed Gu Taesung without hesitation.

"As a reminder, if you're thinking of attacking Dansu ahjussi—"

"Why do you think I would?"

Killer King frowned as if slightly offended.

"The only enemy of the Seven Apostles is the Misreading association. I won't attack anyone else."

It looked like he had already killed a lot for that kind of thing, but there was no need to make useless tackles right away.

"Anyway, at this rate, there's a high chance that guy will collect all seven star jewels."

I think so too.

Even now, the Misreading association, who is scattered all over the maze, is trying to feed the man with the remaining star jewels.

They will be looking for opportunities.

"The guys from the Misreading association must be planning on summoning the death sword with the man as a sacrifice and only steal the item."

"We have to find ahjussi before they do."

[2 hours and 58 minutes left until the relocation.]

There was still a lot of free time until the next relocation.

The problem is that the entire 'labyrinth' is reset, making it impossible to know the location of Dansu ahjussi.

"I need a guide. Do you have any related skills or attributes?"

However, neither Killer King nor Literature Girl 64 had the relevant skills or characteristics.

Literature Girl 64 and Shin Yoosung were looking at each other a few steps away.

Killer King licked his lips.

"The composition of the party is really bad. At this time, Yoo Sangah or Lee Gilyoung should have been there."

Surely that was right.

In <Kim Dokja's Company>, there are two incarnations that can find a way in a maze.

But now, neither Yoo Sangah nor Lee Gilyoung were here.

Dansu ahjussi, who was able to play the role of Lee Gilyoung, is wandering around the labyrinth as a monster.

We have to find a way.

A way to find Dansu ahjussi before the guys from the Misreading association.

I thought about it.

"What would Kim Dokja do?"

It was then that the message resonated in my head.

[All repairs from Record Repairer have ended.]

Finally, the repair of the 'record repairer' is over.

But I didn't have high expectations.

The person I possessed now is Cheon Inho, and even if Cheon Inho's records were corrected, it didn't seem like there would be any major changes.

However.

['Record Repairer' repairs skills that were inactive.]

An unexpected message came.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' has been activated.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 657 Episode 19 People of the Past (9)

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[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint was an exclusive skill mainly used by Kim Dokja. This skill consisted of a total of 3 stages, and each stage had different abilities.]

The first step was to read 'simple actions and emotions of the characters'.

The second step was to listen to the character's inner thoughts.

Finally, the third step is to share the character's vision or immerse yourself in the character themself.

It was a skill I knew very well. The problem is why the skill was activated only after the 'record repairer' repaired it.

「There is no way that Cheon Inho has [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].」

If so, it means that this is a skill created in the process of repairing my records.

Come to think of it, it wasn't too outrageous.

It was because there was a possibility that I might have at least one such fragment, just as Dansu ahjussi and other readers have a 'fragment of Kim Dokja'.

In a sense, a writer is also a 'reader' who reads his own writing.

If I have a fragment of Kim Dokja who has learned [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], it'll give me luck.

Let's not think complicated.

For now, I need to think about how to use this skill.

"Shin Yoosung."

I called Shin Yoosung who was by my side.

According to my memory, there are three conditions for using [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

One, the subject must be a 'character'.

Two, the 'understanding' of the subject must be above a certain level.

Third, the subject and I should be thinking about each other at the same time.

Now, if I talk to Shin Yoosung, the above three conditions are likely to be fulfilled at the same time.

At my call, Shin Yoosung looked up at me. I could see the child's little eyes roll back and forth.

But why?

No matter how long I waited, [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] did not activate.

Is it because of a lack of understanding?

Or, is Shin Yoosung not thinking of me right now?

Shin Yoosung, who was staring at me, asked.

"You called me differently earlier."

Differently?

There was a memory that came to mind later.

「"Get down, Yoosoung."」

When I [incited] myself to be Yoo Joonghyuk a while ago, I definitely said that to Shin Yoosung.

It wasn't intentional.

Because at that time, I really thought that I was Yoo Joonghyuk, and [Incite] is such a skill.

"You didn't even use honorifics."

"That… sorry, it’s a kind of side effect."

"You can just call me comfortably."

Hearing the voice of a child looking at me in anticipation, I didn't know what to say for a moment.

"I'll try."

"Really?"

It was at best not to use honorifics. Calling out the child's name as it is.

Although it was a very simple task, it was seldom easy for me.

I know why. It was because too many memories flooded in when I saw Shin Yoosung in front of me.

Shin Yoosung of the 41st round.

To me, this Shin Yoosung has wandered for thousands of years in the labyrinth of the world line. It was Shin Yoosung, who was reincarnated as a dokkaebi after descending as the Disaster of Floods.

What I see is a grand tragedy that has yet to come to this child.

If so, am I not seeing the current Shin Yoosung properly?

"Did you find a method?"

It was Literature Girl 64 who spoke.

"Not yet. Yerin-ssi."

After a while, I called her by her real name.

Literature Girl 64 was the only reader I knew of by her real name.

The person who read writer 'Lee Hakhyun'’s book.

Even though she doesn't know that I'm Lee Hakhyun, I still feel affinity when I see her.

Shin Yoosung pulled on my sleeve and asked.

"Is it a friend of yours?"

"Yes."

"Are you close?"

Why does Shin Yoosung ask such a question about everyone?

Maybe it's because I have a borderline personality.

"Yes. We're close."

Those words came from Literature Girl 64, not me.

When Shin Yoosung looked at Literature Girl 64 with strange eyes, Literature Girl 64 also looked down at Shin Yoosung with an unfamiliar look.

LiteraryGirl64 spoke again.

"We both like books."

"Books."

Shin Yoosung's golden eyes blinked violently.

I could see the expression of Literature Girl 64 hardening. And the next moment.

「Strange.」

For a moment, I felt a tickle in my ears, and then I heard a soft sound.

「Shin Yoosung in the third round does not have golden eyes. The 41st round will be the same. That’s right, this Shin Yoosung now—」

"Yerin."

"Yes."

['Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is unlocked.]

As Literature Girl 64 looked at me, her voice also cut off.

What I just heard was the inner thoughts of the literary girl.

But can it?

「'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is a skill that can only be used on 'characters'.」

However, Literature Girl 64 was a reader, not a character.

The cool realization came to mind as a clear sentence.

「[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] could be used on 'readers' as well.」

I immediately looked back at Killer King. Coincidentally, Killer King was also looking at me.

「Are you staring at me?」

A voice that sounds like he’s been waiting for it.

[Now Cheon Inho is closer to 'Kim Dokja' than anyone else among the apostles.]

「Then, if I beat that guy, does this mean I will become the closest to Yoo Joonghyuk?」

Seeing him having absurd delusions, it must have been Killer King’s inner thoughts.

I then thought of Dansu ahjussi.

However, the thoughts of the old man were not heard.

It could have been because his mind was too frozen, or it could have been because Dansu ahjussi wasn't thinking of me.

If only Dansu ahjussi could think of me.

If that's possible, it's possible to determine the ahjussi’s position in the labyrinth.

I immediately took out an item that did not bounce the wind speed.

'The horn of provocation.'

Spoils obtained from killing an ancient Nagak.

By using this item, I will be able to spread my voice throughout the labyrinth.

If ahjussi heard my voice, wouldn't he think of me even for a moment?

It was a gamble worth taking.

The problem is that ahjussi is farther away than expected, so the [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] step 2 didn't activate.

"Yerin."

"Yes."

"You have the iron fist you used before."

The question mark was omitted.

Killer King, who was brushing his sword while imitating Yoo Joonghyuk, spoke.

"It looks like you're talking about Vision Oh's Dark Spinning Breaker."

I guess that was the name.

Anyway.

"Use that on me now."

If step 2 doesn't work, use step 3.

---

In the dark, the man thought.

"Who am I?"

The man was thinking about himself.

Who am I.

The man thought it was an invincible philosophical question.

No human being knows what he is. He is only called by his name from birth.

He pondered what he was called.

「Lee Dansu.」

Right.

Lee Dansu was called that.

That was his name

"No."

No. Actually, that wasn't his name. That name was someone else's.

The name of the one who was once the master of this body.

He was just borrowing his name.

Then what was his name?

His name is.

"Noh Jiyoon. Noh Jiyoon."

There were memories that came one by one in the voice that came out of his mouth.

Right. He is Noh Jiyoon's father.

「Noh Gyeonghwan.」

That was his name.

「My father gave me such a name so that I could live vigilantly against even the slightest trouble. Thanks to the name my father gave me, I managed to live without much trouble.」

If you think about it, Noh Gyeonghwan's life was smooth and peaceful.

He's been like that since he was a kid.

Noh Gyeonghwan was born with a handsome face.

He never caught the flu, which everyone else gets, he studied well, and his friendships were good.

Luckily, he entered a prestigious university, and he also had a good random number draw in the military, so he was assigned to a comfortable place.

He obtained a small but cozy home with subscription bankbooks he had collected since childhood, and met his beautiful and wise wife like fate.

The daughter born between them was also very lovely.

Because he was so lucky in life, Noh Gyeonghwan often wondered if he was borrowing someone's luck.

Maybe the reason he is happy in this world is because somewhere in the distant universe someone else is unhappy.

Noh Gyeonghwan often imagined someone who might have been unhappy because of him, and he sang a short song for them every time he got home from work.

His wife loved his songs.

「Then one day, misfortune came to him too.」

Maybe it wasn't even a big deal. A tragedy that happens to everyone. It was just that the tragedy befell him.

「His wife was dead.」

The problem was the cause.

If it was a traffic accident or myocardial infarction, he doesn't know if he would have been able to understand it even though it was difficult. He was out of luck, and might have let go of his beloved wife, bursting into tears at his exasperation.

But his wife was killed.

「This is a stone.」

It was a stone. A very small stone that even a child can carry.

「"It seems that it fell from the sky. There was a meteor warning the day before, but it's a very rare thing. Our country wasn't even an alert area...」

It was a meteorite that flew from the other side of the universe.

A small meteorite that flew through the darkness of hundreds of thousands of light years and burned the heat of the atmosphere. His wife was hit by the stone and died instantly as it went through her body.

「"It is a disaster. Really, you're out of luck—"」

Can it really be explained with the word 'unlucky'? Noh Gyeonghwan did not understand.

He suddenly thought of 'someone' who was unfortunate beyond the universe.

Is this really a disaster?

Could it be that someone from far beyond the universe, envious of his happiness, threw a stone at him?

「From then on, Noh Gyeonghwan often looked up at the sky.」

He thought of an unprecedented meteorite that had flown in from beyond the sky.

His father was right.

You should be vigilant even for small troubles. Even now, he has to live up to his name.

From then on, Noh Gyeonghwan lived for the survival of his daughter.

He took his little daughter to school himself. He even wrote a flexible chapter for his daughter, fearing that even he himself would leave in a sudden accident.

He always kept his daughter by his side and kept out any danger.

His little daughter loved and understood Noh Gyeonghwan.

And after understanding so much, she started to hate him.

「"Can you please stop?"」

At some point, the daughter stopped eating her rice well. She stopped going to school.

It was fine though.

You can study later.

At least the house was safe.

If you are at home, you will never die from being hit by a meteorite.

However, Noh Gyeonghwan did not know that he could be hit by a meteorite even at home.

「"Yoo Joonghyuk."」

It was a name like a meteorite that flew from an unknown place.

「"I will marry Yoo Joonghyuk."」

---

['Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is unlocked!]

"Uweak!"

I jumped up from my seat with a feeling of vomiting.

Looking at the timer in the air, the time I fainted was only about ten minutes.

Killer King supported me and asked.

"Did you find him?"

"I found him."

"How?"

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint was indeed activated.]

A little while ago, I became Dansu ahjussi and peeped into his memories.

I explained to Killer King and Literature Girl 64 the approximate location of Dansu ahjussi and then said:

"I don't have time to explain in detail. Since we used 'Devaal's Fire Flute' earlier, the enemies must have noticed our presence."

Busy footsteps were heard throughout the dungeon. I'm sure the other the guys from the Misreading association are also looking for Dansu ahjussi.

"We have to find ahjussi first."

There is only one way to do that.

I gulped up blood and looked at the Literature Girl 64 once again.

"Hit me one more time. This time, to the point where I'll really die."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 658 Episode 19 People of the Past (10)

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「"I will marry Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Noh Gyeonghwan's life changed after his daughter was taken away by some fictional character.

He had neither the energy to be angry nor the energy to be sad.

He just quietly accepted that his entire life had been destroyed by a meteorite that flew for no reason.

But even after his life was destroyed, life continued.

Noh Gyeonghwan lived.

He somehow lived a day, ate rice. He did his job and got paid.

He was the head of the family and had responsibilities.

But at that time, Noh Gyeonghwan did not know.

Just as his wife and daughter were hit by a meteorite, there was a meteorite left in this world that was assigned to him.

「"It's cancer."」

It was a medical examination he had given without much thought.

Noh Gyeonghwan thought he had heard it wrong. He asked again and again.

「"It's cancer."」

It was a much more probable event than a meteorite. But probable events are not always easy to accept.

「"There are often cases like this. Some people hardly feel the signs. Aren't you usually very tired?」

Is there anyone who is not normally tired?

However, listening to the doctor's words, it seemed that he had been more tired lately.

「"You'd better prepare your mind."」

How to prepare my mind?

I will die soon.

Is accepting that fact a mental preparation?

"I won't kill you. I won't kill you."

If he prepares with such a heart, what will become of his daughter now?

"Noh Jiyoon. Noh Jiyoon."

I don't know.

Where did it go wrong?

"Find someone."

Why are these things happening to him? What the hell did he do wrong?

It was a meaningless question.

He knew that too.

This was a normal human life, and there is no reasonable probability in ordinary human life.

Because it's not a story about his life.

—Ahjussi! Dansu ahjussi!

No one is watching his life, and that is why there is no one to point out the probabilities.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' looks at his incarnation.]

Noh Gyeonghwan did not tell his daughter about his illness.

His words became less and less familiar, and instead, the time spent talking alone in the room increased.

It was more like he was talking to his internet friends rather than talking to himself.

When he was always alone, he thought that he was fortunate to have a channel of communication with his daughter, but on the other hand, he was worried that bad people would attack her.

But he couldn't interfere with what was going on inside his daughter's room.

All that Noh Gyeonghwan could do was prepare meals for his daughter and carefully ask questions he would not normally ask.

「"When are you going to school?"」

Jiyoon's expression as she pouted her lips.

「"You said I don’t have to go?"」

Was his method right?

Did he raise his daughter properly?

In fact, he was trying to prepare for a destruction that would never come, but rather destroyed his daughter's life.

Looking at the half of the sandwich his daughter left behind, Noh Gyeonghwan suddenly thought of that.

「Actually, it wasn't the meteorite that ruined his daughter, but it was him himself.」

It was then that he started secretly reading the novels his daughter was reading.

Before he died, he wanted to understand his daughter at least a little. He even wondered what kind of guy his daughter liked, Yoo Joonghyuk.

「There are three ways to survive in a destroyed world.」

The novel was bizarre from the first sentence.

「I have forgotten some of them now. But one thing is certain. It is the fact that you who are reading this now will survive.」

In some way, he wondered if he started reading this story because he wanted to live.

Can he really survive by reading this novel?

Even though he knew it sounded like a dream, he started reading the novel.

However, to him, who has become somewhat of an 'old person' now, the contents of the novel were embarrassing.

「"Kim Dokja. My father gave me that name so that I could be a strong man by myself."」

Kim Dokja.

It was a strange name.

Even for a man who is not well versed in literature, the name has a rather contrived symbolism.

「"Even if everyone didn’t say it, I believe you would have noticed what the situation was. Exclusive skills and a system window. Game-like interface. Is there anyone who still hasn’t mastered games?"」

Even the character told a story he was unfamiliar with. System window. Game-like interface. Regression, reincarnation, possession... Strange and absurd materials.

Do kids these days like this?

As he scrolled down like that, he sometimes came across a story he knew.

The Shang Dynasty and the Later Three Kingdoms period. Kim Yushin and Yi Sunshin.

Even though he wondered if this was a distortion of history, when a story he knew came out, he turned the page excitedly.

When he liked the Olympus Myth or Journey to the West, he thought that they were fairly educational novels, and when complicated settings or worldviews came out, he wondered if Jiyoon knew all of them.

When a cruel description related to the Apocalypse came out, he was worried and wanted to leave a comment, but he held back.

As he read it like that, one line became one page, and one page became another chapter. Two, three, four, he read the story.

All stories have a strange power.

The main character has nothing in common with him. Nevertheless, while reading the story, Noh Gyeonghwan felt connected to the main character.

He became Kim Dokja, cleared the scenarios, ventured the world, and built up stories.

He gradually understood why his daughter liked the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.

「Perhaps Jiyoon wanted to go back.」

Even if it revolves hundreds or thousands of times, even if it means destroying this world for just one person.

「She would have wanted her mother back.」

Now Jiyoon is alone.

What story can he leave to his daughter?

「"Dad."」

What kind of story will be written about the only daughter of the human Noh Gyeonghwan?

「"Give me a ride."」

Jiyoon said she had a place to go with her internet friend.

After dropping off his daughter in front of a theater in Chungmuro, Noh Gyeonghwan headed to the hospital. Because it was the day he was given a check-up.

He remembered arriving at the hospital safely and going to the reception desk. But his memories after that were sparse.

Collapsed with vertigo, what a gentleman in a bowler hat lacked him for. And… It's over now, he thought.

If only they had a little more time.

If he could talk to his daughter one last time.

'I read your favorite story too.'

It would be nice if he could say that.

「There are three ways to survive in a destroyed world.」

In the midst of his increasingly blurred consciousness, Noh Gyeonghwan wanted to believe in a fictional story.

「This is a story for only one reader.」

If there really is such a story, he wanted to ask for a miracle for him too.

"I won't kill you. I won't kill you."

The voice that came out of his throat was unfamiliar.

"I won't kill you."

—Ahjussi!

The fog in his head cleared, and Noh Gyeonghwan regained consciousness.

But his vision turned black and he couldn't see anything.

Instead, certain memories came to mind.

「He entered Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint. Did someone grant his wish at the last moment?」

He entered this world and was still alive. He was still alive and searching for his daughter.

"Run away!"

"Crazy, crazy—"

"Everyone, don't be fooled. You won't die even if you get hit by that nerd! They say he won't kill you either!"

In his messy mind, pictures gradually came to life.

The tragedy at Geumho Station.

He also remembered meeting Cheon Inho.

「Inho-ssi.」

What happened to Inho-ssi?

The only trustworthy man he met after coming to this world.

He saw him for the first time, but it doesn't seem like the first time he has seen him.

"All right. Throw it! Feed him another one!"

"Now!"

I felt like something was flying, and then he heard a pop in his ear.

[You have acquired an additional 'Star Jewel'!]

[A total of 6 star jewels have been obtained.]

[Step 6 of Madness!]

I vomited blood.

Flooding memories ran through my mind at random.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' shouts to wake up!]

Why did it have to be like this?

He just wanted his daughter back.

He would do anything to get his daughter back.

「"Can you really do anything?"」

So he gave in to temptation.

「"There is a way to find your daughter."」

The scenery of the theater that dyes his mind.

A fluttering white coat.

Representative Kim Dokja.

「"Bring the [Death Sword]. Then I will tell you where your daughter is."」

The Death Sword.

Right. He came to this dungeon to get it.

"Noh Jiyoon. Noh Jiyoon."

In a hazy memory, Noh Gyeonghwan asked Representative Kim Dokja.

「"Why did you bring me to this novel?"」

He wanted to know.

"Why did the meteorite fall? Why did my wife have to die? Why did I get cancer?"

He didn't expect an answer.

However.

「"Do you want to know?"」

The answer came back.

「"Why did a meteorite fly to your family that day? It had to be you and not someone else. Are you really curious?"」

「"Is there really a reason for my unhappiness?"」

「"If you bring the 'Sword of Death', I will tell you all the reasons."」

Representative Kim Dokja provided some equipment and skills, and even gave him the coordinates of the 'death sword'.

「"Why are you helping me?"」

「"Because there is someone who comes to mind when I see you."」

For the first time, something similar to emotion appeared on Representative Kim Dokja's face.

「"He was also a father who cared very much for his daughter."」

What that meant, Noh Gyeonghwan could not understand.

All he could know was that there was a cause for all his unhappiness.

"What, what. These bastards. Where did they come from?"

“It’s an apostle! They are apostles!"

"Ahhh!"

"White and Blue Steel! Ki, Kim Dokja?"

That someone made him suffer this way.

—Ahjussi! Calm down!

A distant voice as if coming from the other side of the universe.

"I won't kill you. I won't kill you-"

Noh Gyeonghwan thought.

I will not forgive you. If anyone has a cause that made his life this way.

"I'll kill you."

His hand held something on fire.

Quadduk.

A voice came along with the sound of his muscles bursting.

"Ahjussi."

It was a voice he knew, but he couldn't remember whose it belonged to.

"I don’t want to do this either. However."

The owner of the voice spoke while enduring the pain.

"I'll fool you just once."

His voice at that moment.

"I am."

It sounded like the first sentence of a novel.

"Noh Jiyoon."

At that moment, the vision in front of his eyes suddenly opened.

A white page appeared in the darkness where nothing could be seen.

Someone was writing a sentence on the blank page.

「There was a girl there. Small stature with a round face. Eyebrows slightly more open than others. Plump cheeks that haven’t lost all of their meat.」

The sentence soon became a person's face.

Noh Gyeonghwan reached out his hand toward the girl's face.

Jiyoon-ah.

「The daughter he loved said.」

"Pass the star jewel to me."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 659 Episode 19 Reader (1)

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I didn't plan to use [Incite] from the beginning.

If ahjussi's reason still remained, I intended to use [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] to stop him somehow.

"I won't kill you! I won't kill you!"

Dansu ahjussi, who could be seen from afar, repeated the same words as if screaming.

Even though I knew it wouldn't work, I shouted again.

"Ahjussi! Calm down!"

I managed to find the location of Dansu ahjussi using [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], but that was it.

My [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] could see the world through that person's eyes and read their memories, but I couldn't empathize with that person.

「Is it because my understanding of him is not enough?」

A man who has lived his entire life for his daughter.

A man who lost his wife and fell ill himself.

Now I understand why the man was wearing a hospital gown at the last 'banquet'.

Perhaps that was the last appearance of Dansu ahjussi before he was possessed.

"Dansu ahjussi! I'm Cheon Inho."

I had to stop Dansu ahjussi somehow. However, ahjussi had already absorbed the five star jewels and was in the 5th stage of madness.

Aaaaaang!

The labyrinth vibrated violently. Killer King, who was watching the situation from the side, said a word.

"What great physical abilities. If you get close, you'll be crushed to the bone."

The incarnations brushed by ahjussi’s fist swung and splattered blood.

"Are you going to do it anyway?"

"I have to."

However, the road to ahjussi did not seem easy.

The reason was that the provocative fire flute I used attracted not only Dansu ahjussi but also others.

The wild beasts from all over the labyrinth are aiming for ahjussi.

Most of them were the embodiment of the Misreading association.

"It's the Misreading association."

Not all members of the union are from the 'Misreading association'.

"Kill the Misreading association."

I was about to ask if there was even a radar in the back, but something like a small hal protruded from Killer King's arm. A bow gun with a black sheen.

Even looking at it, it was an S-class item.

Shush shush.

Every time an arrow is fired, an incarnation is knocked down as it runs out in the passageway.

Given the high level of fire rate and accuracy, [Improved fire rate] and [Improved aiming power] were used.

There was no doubt that it was an item with this dwelling place.

The incarnations who were hit by the arrows that flew in rapid succession groaned and screamed.

"The second apostle."

The name of Killer King was called everywhere, as if he had already become a celebrity there.

[A small number of constellations pay attention to 'Incarnation Kang Ilhun'.]

Who would have known that extra Kang Ilhun would become this strong?

Maybe it's because he's attracted the attention of the constellations, but his expression is strangely excited.

"I'll tell you the little ones."

"Catch the second apostle first."

As if they thought the Killer King's existence was threatening, the incarnations of the Alliance started running toward it all at once.

Killer King did not panic and invoked the holy spirit.

A red mist rolls over his whole body.

I immediately recognized what the Holy Spirit was.

Great Warrior Jophiel's '503 Unit'.

When Killer King drew the bowstring, the roasted mist wrapped around the tip of the arrow as if it were alive.

"Everybody, die."

The arrow flew like a shot and caused a dust explosion when it hit the target.

The elites of the '503 Corps', who bounced in all directions like a grenade burst, pierced five or six incarnations nearby at breakneck speed and turned them into beehives.

"Uh. Aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa!"

Frightened, several of members of the union fell.

I hate to admit it, but it was a great sight.

The way he speaks is like Kim Namwoon, but his skills are astonishing even to Yoo Joonghyuk.

Killer King nodded his head with an inexplicable smile, as if he had read my eyes.

"Go. Kim Dokja."

"I’m not."

"I believe."

I don't know what you're talking about, but it seemed like this was the only chance.

As I ran to the floor, Literature Girl 64 followed my steps.

"It's a game my brother often plays."

"I know roughly."

Just like Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Dokja formed a duo in the main story, let's fight together.

"Then what is Yerin’s role?"

"It changes every time."

Literature Girl 64 added while blowing away one of the incarnations that rushed at her with her elegant feet.

"Isn’t it Han Sooyoung now?"

Kim Dokja, Yoo Joonghyuk, and Han Sooyoung.

Wouldn't it be nice if the people here right now were the real them?

[A constellation that has not yet revealed their modifier is watching you.]

If they had turned the impossible into possible, they would have found a way to save Dansu ahjussi.

"Yerin-ssi."

At my words, Literature Girl 64 nodded her head.

An incarnation of powerful energy could be seen right in front of Dansu ahjussi.

The brightly shining Dustman was definitely different from those of other incarnations.

"It's the king."

"I will take care of it."

[Incarnation 'Lee Seyeon' activates 'battle action mode'!]

Literature Girl 64's main skill, which is to enter a command and unfold a continuous skill, was displayed.

However, the king's actions were a little faster.

"Get out of the way everyone!"

I have to stop it somehow.

However, the passage was once again blocked by the members of the union that came from the side passage.

Killer King's support shots, which flew in from time to time, were also gradually delayed.

It was because of the appearance of long-distance power over there.

"Shoot!"

Troops of arrows holding each bow were lined up on the other side of the aisle.

I reflexively swung my sword while supplying magic power to the broken faith.

['Blade of Faith' is activated!]

I barely managed to remove the single arrows, but the destructive power of each arrow was heavy.

It seemed that there was an incarnation with specialized archery skills.

Can I break through?

It wasn't impossible if [Incite] was used.

Like when dealing with the ark of the Beggar Sect, if I borrow the power of Kyrgios, I can break through the arrows and reach Dansu ahjussi's nose at once.

The problem was then.

When I have already exhausted my strength with [Strengthen Sentence], will I still have the energy to stop Dansu ahjussi?

It was then that I got a message from the group chat in my ear.

—Ahjussi, get down.

I reflexively grabbed Literature Girl 64 by the shoulder and made her get down.

Looking back, I saw Shin Yoosung touching the ground with her palm. At the same time, portals swayed in the maze.

[Monster Gate.]

I was surprised.

Was Shin Yoosung able to open the gate at this point?

Beyond the gate, dozens of Nagaks, who had been tamed by Shin Yoosung, were creeping over.

"What, what! Where did you appear from?!"

The incarnations shot arrows toward the monsters in the air.

Not to be outdone by them, the Nagaks with their mouths wide open began to sing in chorus.

[Nagak Ensemble.]

Even that mighty strong king got thrown in the air and stuck in a stupid place by the bombardment of the pouring sonic waves.

While the surprised incarnations wandered around, Shin Yoosung's voice was heard.

—Go, ahjussi.

Light sparks flew from the body of Shin Yoosung, who was manipulating the Nagaks.

—You said he was close to you.

Shin Yoosung's golden eyes flickered. The eyes of a child who is looking at me but not looking at me at the same time.

—You must never die.

I ran while infusing [Broken Faith] with the [White and Blue Steel]. Cutting off the limbs of the incarnations with the new soldier's blade, I ran towards ahjussi.

"Okay, throw it! Feed him another one!"

But they were faster than me.

The star jewel that flew through the air reached the dust man of Dansu ahjussi. With a whimpering sound, ahjussi’s whole body began to flatten once again.

[Incarnation 'Lee Dansu' acquired 1 additional Star Jewel'!]

[A total of 6 star jewels have been acquired.]

[Incarnation 'Lee Dansu' enters 'Madness Stage 6'.]

"Yerin!"

The moment the king opened his eyes and turned around, Literature Girl 64's weave hit the boy's face.

I didn't let go of his back and arrived right in front of Dansu ahjussi's nose.

Once again, the giant Dansu let out a painful groan.

Tears flowed non-stop from the old man's eyes.

Now, just by going near Dansu ahjussi, I felt creepy.

An alarm bell rang in my head.

Was this how I felt when I first met Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round?

I know how to feel when faced with a different species with different physical abilities.

[The overall stats of 'Incarnation Cheon Inho' have exceeded the scenario limits.]

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint is not deterred. There is no chance of winning in a head-to-head fight.]

「There is only one way left.」

I didn't want to write this way.

"I won't kill you. I won't kill you."

The old man held out his hand towards me. It was in slow motion, so I could have avoided it if I wanted to.

But I didn't escape.

So to speak, this.

"I will kill you."

It was my small atonement for Dansu ahjussi.

My one arm twisted with a groaning sound.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.9' is activated!]

[I am Yoo Joonghyuk.]

As the steel-like sensation of Yoo Joonghyuk penetrated into my brain, I was able to barely keep my senses even in the distant pain.

"Ahjussi. I don't want to do this either. But."

He looked at me as if he was really listening to me.

"I'll fool you just once."

I breathed in as hard as I could to contain the pain.

"I am."

This is a lie that shouldn't be.

Even so, this was the only way to save Dansu ahjussi.

"I am Noh Jiyoon."

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 9' is activated!]

At the same time, ahjussi moved a few times.

The face of the old man with black bloody tears was fixed on me.

The man who can't see anything.

Even so, at this moment, Dansu ahjussi was looking at a certain scenery.

In this world, a scenery that only you and me can see.

「There was a girl there. Small stature with a round face. Eyebrows slightly more open than others. Plump cheeks that haven’t lost all of their meat.」

Dansu ahjussi's cheek muscles moved and the corners of his mouth twitched slowly. In these spasms of subtle emotions, I read the old man's heart in it.

"Pass the star jewel to me."

In this Star Labyrinth, there are a total of two ways to steal someone else's Bell Powder.

One is to become the same group and unify 'Dustman'.

The second is to kill others to get star dust from the dust surface.

But as I guessed, those two methods are not the only ones.

If that were all, other 'kings' would not be able to throw star jewels at Dansu ahjussi.

My guess is this.

If [Dust] is made into a 'Star Jewel', the 'Star Jewel' will become tradeable!

Burrr.

The dust side of Dansu ahjussi in the air is painful.

He shuddered as if he was embarrassed, and soon he made a profit with a wok.

A piece of shiny five-colored stone.

It was a star jewel.

Ahjussi handed me a star jewel like someone would give his daughter his birthday present.

"Ji… yoon… ah."

[You have acquired 1 'Star Jewel'.]

[Entering 'Madness Stage 1'.]

The dustman that was standing above my head ate the star jewel as if it had been waiting for it.

The operation was successful.

The incarnations of the Union, who had been paying attention to the surroundings, were agitated.

If they risk their lives right now, it could be dangerous for both me and Dansu ahjussi.

But as I expected, they wouldn't move.

"Um, that bastard is going through the star jewels?"

"It's okay. Leave it alone."

"It's like he’s indulging in his own greed."

Also, I knew that.

Their goal is the 'death sword'.

It didn't matter to them who collected the 7 star jewels.

8. Every time you acquire 1 'Star Jewel', the 'Madness' value increases.

They clearly understood the 8th rule of the Star Labyrinth.

Due to the 'Madness Penalty', no one can collect '7 Star Jewels' while remaining sane in this labyrinth.

So, it would be their plan to collect 7 star jewels for the sacrificial lamb and take only the summoned death sword.

"Ha ha ha! Eat a lot!"

The ruse was noticed early on.

If this continues, I will become a madman like you.

[Entering 'Madness Stage 2'.]

Every time I acquired a star jewel, I felt my body change.

The overall concentration increased explosively, and the cohesion increased in real time. The dragon's blood vessels cut with a special sound.

[Entering 'Madness Stage 3']

There is a feeling that the volume of the brain is expanding to a size that the skull cannot handle.

But I bit my lip and held on.

I can do it.

I also have equipment with strong anti-magic abilities, and most of all, I have [Incite].

So I was confident.

Even if I fell into madness, I would be able to endure it.

Without losing my sanity, I will be able to collect 7 star jewels, summon the Death Sword, and destroy the absolute throne.

「There is no Kim Dokja in this world.」

That's why I have to.

Only I can block the aspirations of this world.

I saw Killer King and Shin Yoosung shouting at me from afar.

I smiled at them as a sign that I was okay.

[You have acquired 5 star jewels.]

[Entering Madness Stage 5.]

It was dangerous. My eyes hurt as if they would burst, and my vision was stained red.

The hold of reason in my head was weakening.

Now, Dansu ahjussi's overall ability was much weaker than before. I released 'Noh Jiyoon''s [Incite] and showed my final concentration.

What I need now is someone who can withstand this terrible madness.

There were candidates that came to mind.

Yoo Joonghyuk, Jung Heewon, Han Sooyoung, and Lee Hyunsung.

But it didn't seem like they could easily endure this madness.

Now, I needed a person with 'strong mental strength'.

And no matter how much I thought about it, there was only one such person.

A man who has loved only one story for over ten years.

Even after dying several times, he is the main character who never gave up on the ending he wanted.

"I am Kim Dokja."

This is something only Kim Dokja can do.

It was then that an unknown sentence popped up in front of me.

「At that moment, Lee Hakhyun did not know.」

A sentence that comes to mind without a chance to react. It was a phrase I had seen somewhere before.

「The fact that he will never be able to go back to the way he was before.」

The moment I intuited that something was wrong and hurriedly canceled the skill.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.9' is activated!]

I heard something breaking inside me.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 660 Episode 19 Reader (2)

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"Ahjussi! Wake up! Ahjussi!"

Shin Yoosung shook the fallen Cheon Inho. However, no matter how much she shook him, Cheon Inho did not respond.

[Incarnation 'Cheon Inho' is in 'Madness Stage 5'.]

Two times larger than before.

Dark red veins stood out all over Cheon Inho's body, with both eyes closed.

Shin Yoosung thought while suppressing her breathing.

Is he dead?

No. He didn't die. His heart is beating, and he is breathing.

It just doesn't happen.

"He’s still alive. Don't make a fuss about it."

At Killer King’s words, Shin Yoosung narrowed her eyes. Shin Yoosung's eyes blinked violently with golden light.

"Shin Yoosung."

It was Literature Girl 64 who held Shin Yoosung's shoulder.

"It's okay. Inho-ssi isn't dead. He won't die."

As if to reassure Shin Yoosung, Literature Girl 64 repeated the same words over and over again.

Literature Girl 64 confirmed that Shin Yoosung's breathing was gradually stabilizing and she glanced at Killer King.

Killer King, who took a step forward, raised the sitting Lee Dansu.

"Are you okay?"

Lee Dansu staggered and froze..

Is it because the madness state had been lifted? Lee Dansu had a face that had found reason.

He looked around with a guilty expression and asked.

"What happened to Inho-ssi?"

"All right. Not yet."

Cheon Inho, who had fallen into the 5th stage of madness, had black smoke coming out of his body.

Lee Dansu, who was blind, couldn't see the scenery, but he knew what to do from now on.

"We have to share Inho-ssi's star jewels. A person who has acquired more than two star jewels will never be able to stay sane. I can say this because I have personally experienced it."

But Killer King shook his head.

There is no time right now. There is no way.

Cheon Inho must wake up to share the star jewel. But now, Cheon Inho is in a state of fainting.

Even if Cheon Inho was awake, it was questionable whether he would be able to share a star jewel in the current situation.

Killer King counted the number of enemies encircling the front. The number of incarnations of the Alliance remaining was about thirty.

Some of them were incarnations that Killer King was familiar with.

The Assassination King was a face he had never seen before, but the other two were part of the '7 Kings of Seoul' in orv.

If there is a difference from the main story, it seems that other souls have possessed them as well.

"Illegal reading."

Despite Killer King's provocation, there was no reaction from the alliance.

They were arguing over Cheon Inho's condition.

—Why didn't he become a monster?

— Mental strength is strong and can be enhanced.

—Who is that guy?

—The constellations say 'Cheon Inho'.

— Cheon Inho, the role of the agitator in Geumho?

—Who is that? Was there ever such a strong person?

The three kings glared at Killer King at the same time.

—The opponent is second apostle. Can we get rid of him?

—The person possessed by him is 'Kang Ilhun. This incarnation’s natural talent is terrible, but the problem is Jophiel. The woman next to him is said to be the holder of the 100 Cheongganggi.

—There is also a kid who looks like Shin Yoosung. It's going to be tough.

— Shall I call the tyrant?

—If you call it, you can hunt without damage, but you don't have to go that far here. In any case, the summoning of the 'Sword of Death' has been confirmed. We just need to take it away.

As they kept quiet, Killer King opened his mouth.

"Boring. Are you done talking now?"

The three kings, startled by those words, all turned to Killer King.

Killer King said with a dark smile.

"[Translation] is a skill that seals and transmits words with magical power. A super high level like me can destroy the condensed magic."

It was a lie, of course. Killer King was not a super master of Murim, and he didn't even have that kind of sponsor.

However, the Killer King was able to vaguely guess the contents even without listening to the conversation.

It was the power of Killer King's skill, [Juron].

It won't turn out the way you think. Because Kim Dokja is strong, Kim Dokja?

"This guy is Kim Dokja."

Killer King covered Cheon Inho with his finger.

The reactions of the incarnations were different.

A golden light flickered in Shin Yoosung's eyes once again, and Lee Dansu tilted his head. Literature Girl 64 touched her forehead as if thinking it was starting again.

The kings of the union looked confused.

“That guy is Kim Dokja?"

Killer King shook his head as if they were pathetic.

"You sound stupid. If you narrow your eyes, everyone becomes narrow-eyed."

"I didn't even hear that he was blonde."

"It seems that you don’t know Kim Dokja had a blonde hair in 'Kaizenix' and 'Journey to the West.'"

The kings looked at each other as if embarrassed by Killer King's eloquence.

King Sosim belatedly refuted.

"Whatever you say, you guys are doomed. A human who falls into the 5th stage of Madness will inevitably become a monster. The blind guy earlier didn't kill people, so it took a long time to collect the star dust, but that guy will be different. He will soon kill all the incarnations around him, including you."

"Kim Dokja is a non-killer. Have you forgotten?"

"Immortal...?"

"And Kim Dokja has a [fourth wall]. It's just 'Madness'. It means you won't get hit by anything."

Killer King looked at Cheon Inho like a man who really believed in his words.

"The fourth wall is invincible. Kim Dokja, who has it, is a god, this girl is actually Han Sooyoung, and Yoo Joonghyuk is the strongest."

"What are you talking about-"

"Anyway, there's a deep secret hidden in this story that you guys don't know about."

Killer King talked nonstop and exchanged glances with Literature Girl 64.

—You must take your time.

The number on this side was a total of five, one of which was a Cheon Inho who was incapacitated.

On the other hand, there are only three kings and a number of over thirty.

If they open an all-out war with them right now, even if they win, the damage won’t be minimal.

[After a while, the entire dungeon will be engulfed in flames.]

[Explore the 'Safe Area'.]

Fortunately, time was on their side.

When the 'Safe Zone' is activated, they will be engulfed in flames and the maze will be relocated.

Belatedly noticing Killer King’s strategy, the kings hardened their complexions.

—Damn it, it was just a waste of time.

[Relocate in 5 minutes]

5 minutes left. The kings had to choose.

Are they going to take the risk and fight Killer King's party now? Or will they explore the safe area?

['Safe Area' is activated.]

The worry didn't last long.

It was because a huge 'safe zone' had appeared nearby at just the right time.

"Everyone get into the safe area!"

Two safe areas appeared.

It was a size that could accommodate both the incarnations of the union and Cheon Inho in each.

Literature Girl 64 and Shin Yoosung moved to a safe area due to lack of space with Dansu.

Killer King also dragged Cheon Inho to a safe area.

Cheon Inho, who acquired the star jewels, did not have to enter the safe area, but the decision was made considering the relocation of the labyrinth.

At least if they're together, they won't be swept away by the relocation and the party won’t be scattered.

The Assassination King, who was glaring at Killer King, asked.

"Is he really Kim Dokja?"

"Yes."

"I can't believe it at all because it's crazy."

The Assassination King shook his head in disgust, then added.

"Whether he is Kim Dokja or not, you will have no choice but to give him a star jewels."

"What?"

"Only then will all of you guys survive."

Before he could ask what that meant, the entire labyrinth was covered in flames.

[Safe Area is activated.]

[Rearrangement begins.]

The bright fire burned everything nearby.

In the place where the flames that had been burning for a while disappeared like an illusion, the power of the kings and the alliance were nowhere to be seen.

"They ran away."

Why? The union did not pursue them and chose to leave the dungeon.

It was an incomprehensible choice.

This is because if they leave the dungeon, they will lose all the 'star dust' they had.

In fact, a large amount of star dust fell where they disappeared.

Killer King looked at the fallen Cheon Inho.

Cheon Inho was still in a state where he is not in progress.

If Cheon Inho wakes up and steals the star jewels from Lee Dansu then picks up all the star dust that has fallen on the floor, he will be able to collect all 7 star jewels.

Killer King and Literature Girl 64, who exchanged glances with each other, approached to take star dust at the same time.

This was to prevent any catastrophe from happening.

[Incarnation 'Kang Ilhun' acquired 1 additional 'Star Jewel'!]

The dust man in the air hummed, and the last star jewel was born.

They finally collected all seven star jewels.

The problem is how to summon the 'death sword' with this.

An ominous feeling passed through Killer King's mind.

—Whether he is Kim Dokja or not, you will have no choice but to give him star jewels.

Killer King's [Recommendation] has been activated.

The union’s plan is to summon the 'Sword of Death' by driving 7 Star Jewels into 'one place'.

However, there was a loophole in their plan.

'How did they plan to kill the incarnation who obtained the 'Death Sword' by collecting 7 star jewels?'

"Yerin."

Since when was it?

A red meteorite fell where the stardust that had been piled up was gone.

"Flee."

Literature Girl 64 instinctively stepped back and looked at her brother's complexion.

He was Killer King who wasn't nervous even when he was fighting against a 6th grade monster. However, sweat was forming on Killer King's neck.

"It's a disaster."

Light from a red meteorite began to cover the maze.

---

When I woke up, I was being pulled into the cold deep sea.

I looked back at my previous memories.

I was in a confrontation with Dansu ahjussi and used [Incite].

I remember going there.

But why did I suddenly fall into the sea?

No, is this really the 'sea' in the first place?

I blankly looked down at my feet.

Endless depths.

There was an abyss with a black mouth open.

I could feel it instinctively.

"I shouldn’t go there…"

If I go there, I can never come back.

「However, even knowing that fact, Lee Hakhyun felt a strange curiosity.」

A strange impulse arose.

I think I want to stop being comfortable. The thought of wanting to throw everything away and go inside.

A vague expectation that the truth I was looking for would be found in that abyss.

The secret of this world that I wanted to know so much. A strange belief that every story has an ending gripped me.

The limbs that were vigorously stirred are slowly gaining strength lost.

Would it be okay?

「If I go over there.」

If I had done this, I would have worked hard enough that anyone would admit it.

So stop.

「What about other 'readers'?」

The moment I remembered that question, my mind flashed.

I reflexively raised my left hand up. Even though I knew there was nothing there, I struggled with my hands and feet like someone trying to grab something.

At that moment, something touched my fingertips.

I knew that feeling.

I suddenly got out of breath.

That's the feeling when you just put your hand on the keyboard.

The senses of a living patient, fluctuating like a freshly caught fish.

[The exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is activated!]

I grabbed that sentence as best I could.

Then the sentences began to speak.

「Kyung Sein thought…」

Kyung Sein.

The second reader I met.

ID JudgeHeewon. Complete reading 1.8 times. Among the characters, she likes Jung Heewon the most.

It was as if I could catch a glimpse of Kyung Sein's face through the intertwined typefaces.

When parting ways in Chungmuro, Kyung Sein followed Lee Hyunsung.

「Is Inho-ssi okay?」

I see you're thinking of me right now.

A corner of my heart was touched and a strange power welled up.

I can't give up here.

There are readers out there.

There is a story that has not yet been told to them.

I grabbed the sentence and held out my hand once again.

Then another sentence came into my hand this time. It was a sentence with a much sharper sense than a moment ago.

「Goo Seonah thought.」

I don't want to die.」

Goo Seonah. A reader I met in the theater dungeon.

ID strawberry1137. Completed 8 times.

「Gu Seon-ah thought. Shed too much blood.」

Kim Kyung-shik bastard. Why is there a pig there?」

Goo Seonah seemed to be in a crisis. I could see her back as she wandered through the labyrinth, bleeding.

Apparently, Kim Gyeongshik, whom he was traveling with, is dead.

Another reader died somewhere I don't know.

「Damn members of the Misreading association...」

Her voice was getting weaker and weaker.

I wanted to help.

I wanted to tell her that she shouldn't die there, that she should come to her senses. But my voice didn't come out.

「I can't die here.」

Goo Seonah's breathing slowed down. Her staggered vision shook greatly with every limp.

「The bastard must have possessed someone. I won't die until I find my son. Never...」

After saying those words, Goo Seonah sat down on the floor.

The sound of her footsteps running in the distance.

She squeezed the last of her strength and pulled out her rebar, but her fighting strength was no longer there.

The voices of people crying urgently.

Fortunately, it was not the enemies who came running.

「"—Are you okay?"」

I don't know who. But strangely, I felt a longing from the voice I heard.

I caught on to the next sentence without pause.

「Ye Hyunwoo thought.」

'It can't be okay anymore. I have to enter the dungeon.」

Ye Hyunwoo. Completed the novel 50 times.

The 7th apostle is still safe.

「You pitiful bastard. Calm down. If he is Kim Dokja, he should overcome this level.」

Killer King. Completed 100 times. This friend is still the same.

「Wake up.」

Literature Girl 64. Completed 12.8 times...

Stretching out and extending my hand, I listened to the stories of my readers.

It should have been me telling the story, but rather they were telling me the story.

However, there were also stories I had never seen before.

「"Dad…"」

I got goosebumps for a moment.

I hurriedly grabbed the sentence.

But that sentence didn't say anything to me.

I couldn't see any scenery beyond the crest.

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint didn't activate. Maybe.]

All the readers I've seen so far have been 'readers I've met'.

「"Dad."」

But at that moment, I began to see this difficult landscape.

It was impossible.

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint is activated only for the 'characters' I know and only for the 'characters' who think of me.]

That is.

「If I had met Dansu ahjussi's daughter without knowing it, and Dansu ahjussi's daughter was thinking of me right now.」

It was impossible.

However, there was one hypothesis that would make the impossible a reality.

[The exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is strongly activated!]

「"Dad."」

Before long, the owner of the voice appeared.

A gloomy landscape felt beyond the sentence. A gloomy darkness.

It was a place I had been to before.

「It was a theater.」

A theater where countless little Kim Dokjas sit and watch the screen.

Kim Dokja who is dazed, Kim Dokja who is having a good time dozing off, Kim Dokja who is grumpy.

Among such Kim Dokjas, there was the Kim Dokja I was looking for.

「Rlaerhwk37.」

Why does this person have to be here?

「"Dad."」

For what purpose should this have to happen?

As if dismissing my doubts, the little Kim Dokjas were just staring at the screen.

「The man with the bleeding from both eyes was there.」

ID wldbsdldkQk80. Read once.

Towards her own father who was engulfed in flames. Jiyoon, who became a kkoma Kim Dokja, reached out her hand.

「"Please save my father, Kim Dokja."」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 661 Episode 19 Reader (3)

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Fiction and reality are different.

Immediately after possessing Kang Ilhun, the first thing Killer King did was to change 'image' into 'text'.

[Incarnation 'Kang Ilhun' activates Observation Lv.4!]

Killer King was not conceited that he knew the future scenarios.

He calmly stored the images he observed in his mind, and transformed the stored images into sentences and converted them into information.

Read. Report. Compare.

He went on to build his own huge database.

[Signs of the fifth main scenario appear.]

The 'database' that had been built up was now warning Killer King.

"That's dangerous."

Killer King instinctively walked away from the meteor, protecting his sister.

Cracked red meteorite.

It was a meteorite that was mentioned in the main part of the book.

It is unknown whether the color and shape are exactly the same as what Kim Dokja saw. However, if you look at the cracked state and the light pouring out, there is no doubt that it contains a monster equivalent to a 'disaster'.

Even in an imminent situation, Killer King did not neglect observation.

First, a green liquid pouring from the stone.

The liquid was causing corrosion as soon as it hit the floor.

The strong acid created a cloud of steam.

Between the thick vapor, something larger than the size of a meteorite was rising.

The sound of heavy footsteps that resounded proved his presence. Immediately, Killer King put his hand into his arms and set off a flare into the darkness.

Then, two sharp blue eyes flashed from the ceiling of the pitch-black labyrinth.

It was a monster species that was about ten meters tall.

[Level 3 poisonous dragon species (lower), 'Lesser Dragon Poisoner' has appeared!]

A giant lizard whose entire body is covered in green scales.

It was a monster comparable to the 'S-class Fire Dragon'.

"Was this the operation of the members of the Misreading association?"

Killer King bit his lip secretly.

The Misreading association’s operation was simple.

First, gather seven star jewels into one person and turn them into a monster, solve a disaster in front of the monster-turned Avatar, and make them fight each other.

The assassin king who was running away said: if you don't give the star jewel to Cheon Inho, everyone will die here.

Oh oh oh!

People all over the place sat down at the poisonous ring of dragon bells.

In the past, there were more Avatars who did not escape using the 'safe area'.

"Crazy. What is that!"

"So, I told you to go out earlier, right?"

"But the star jewel—"

It seemed that they were not incarnations of the Union’s side.

"Sa, save me! Help me!"

"What is this? There was no mention of something like this in the scenario!"

Small and medium-sized groups that are neither on the union’s side nor on the apostle’s side. Among them, there were also images of kings holding brown or purple flags. [Inference] was activated in Killer King's head.

'They were always looking for an opportunity and joined the battle as soon as the alliance left.'

'They will be aiming for the star jewels, so it is impossible to join hands with them,' Killer King quickly concluded, taking a deep breath and looking around.

The modified maze was in the shape of a large clearing centered around the Lesser Dragon Poisoner.

Although there were passages at the edge of the vacant lot, they were all blocked by translucent walls.

"It’s blocked this way too! Damn it!"

Same as in the first scenario.

A 'closed scenario' that controls a certain area.

Killer King was convinced.

"A hidden Scenario will activate."

As if waiting, a dokkaebi appeared in the air with a small spark.

[This. That's really troubling. You're summoning a disaster from the stars!]

Killer King recognized the dokkaebi right away.

「It was not a low-level dokkaebi like Bihyung. Wearing a neat suit, it had two small horns on his head.」

Intermediate dokkaebi Paul.

A dokkaebi who sabotaged Kim Dokja's script from the beginning, but was eventually taken to the executive branch by Kim Dokja's scheme.

[Recently, there have been a lot of incarnations that are overly aggressive, but I never thought they'd do something like this inside a dungeon... What are you going to do if you wake up 'Material Disaster' when you can't even finish the fourth scenario?]

It was a line that was almost similar to the main story.

This means that although the type of disaster has changed, the major trend has not changed.

Paul looked around at the incarnations.

Cheon Inho, Lee Dansu, Literature Girl 64, and Shin Yoosung. Finally, Paul made eye contact with Killer King and smiled inexplicably.

[It's no fun if everyone dies, so I'll try to change the scenario at my discretion.]

**<Hidden Scenario — United you die, scattered you die>**

Category: Hidden

Difficulty: A

Clear Condition: Hunt the Lesser Dragon Poisoner within the time limit, or survive its attacks.

Time limit: 20 minutes

Reward: 3,000 Coins

Failure: Death

*There is a hidden piece hidden in this mission.

As expected, the scenario is the same as the main story.

Killer King sighed in relief.

It wasn't the worst yet.

The situation would have been better if it weren't for the incarnations who were fussing over there.

"Attack! If we all hit it together now, we won’t die!"

"There's no need to be scared! Kill it and share the hidden piece!"

[The king's shout boosts the morale of the Avatars!]

The Avatars burst forth and charged. One of the bravest incarnations even inserted a weapon directly into the body of the poisonous dragon.

"Look at this! This guy gets hit too-"

The upper body of the talking incarnation was blown away by a simple slap of the tail. Afterwards, the incarnations in front collapsed as if something had broken, leaving only their lower bodies intact. The incarnations in the rear screamed at the sheer horror.

"Ooh, wow!"

However, as if that was expected, there was also a group that overcame sacrifices to move ahead.

It was a group led by a king with a purple banner.

"Aim for the weak spot! Attack the eyes and nose!"

The king shouted and at the same time threw the spear imbued with magical power with all his might.

A direct attack method to attack monsters with hard shells. If the enemy wasn't an S-class monster, Killer King would also have lost out to their strategy.

Quaaaaa!

Bright green venom was flowing from the poisonous dragon’s mouth. The polearm wrapped in magical energy melted in the air.

The embarrassed king took a step back and muttered.

"Last match."

The poison that melted the spear spread radially and fell on the heads of the incarnations.

The king, covered entirely in poison, screamed and struggled. It took less than ten seconds for him to turn into green muck.

"Crazy! Run!"

The group members lost control and became a ragtag group and began to run away.

What descended before their eyes was not an enemy that they could deal with.

[A few constellations let out a small laugh!]

At that time, several incarnations found Killer King’s group as they ran away.

"There! What are you doing? Help me quickly!"

"Aren’t those guys the ones with the star jewels?"

"Star jewel! Give me the star jewels!"

If you eat star jewels, you become stronger.

As you become stronger, your survival rate increases.

Perhaps even a 'disaster' can be defeated.

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint. Their thoughts are clearly visible even without it.]

Killer King silently aimed his bowgun at them.

"Hate."

In hands without any mercy or hesitation.

Those who were hit by Killer King started running in the opposite direction again, swearing.

Killer King did not use arrows on the fleeing incarnations. This is because bait was needed to divert the attention of the poisonous species.

Killer King thought to himself as he watched the incarnations being torn apart by the poisonous dragon's claws.

This cold iron scent has protected him and his sister until now. It will probably remain the same in the future.

[A very small number of constellations hold their tongues at the cruelty of the incarnation 'Kang Ilhun'.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' frowns at incarnation of 'Kang Ilhun'.]

Even if it was heartless, there was nothing he could do about it. That 'disaster' was not an enemy that could be easily dealt with, even if one knew the scenario that would unfold in the future.

If Kim Dokja were here, he would come up with a plan.

'Kim Dokja.'

Killer King unconsciously looked at Cheon Inho, who had collapsed.

Aside from his white skin and slim figure, the man certainly looks different from Kim Dokja.

But why does this guy keep reminding him of Kim Dokja?

"I can do it."

Brilliantly swaying brown hair. A subtle glow came from Shin Yoosung’s eyes.

"Everyone, step back. I’ll handle it."

[Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' looks at the incarnation 'Shin Yoosung'.]

[Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' looks at the incarnation 'Shin Yoosung'.]

[Constellation 'Maritime War God' looks at the incarnation 'Shin Yoosung' and tilts his head.]

[Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' looks at the incarnation 'Shin Yoosung' with suspicious eyes.]

[A few constellations doubt the possibility of the incarnation 'Shin Yoosung'.]

As the eyes of the constellations gathered one by one, faint sparks began to bounce from Shin Yoosung's whole body. Shin Yoosung frowned as if the spark was painful.

Killer King's eyes narrowed.

Killer King read the entire novel 100 times. The 100th time he simply read it with his eyes, tearing open, tasting, and chewing everything in the text.

He imagined the novel and read it with insight into the blank spaces that the author did not write. Like Yoo Joonghyuk, who lived 1863 times, he also read with the determination to share the 100th time with Kim Dokja.

[Incarnation 'Kang Ilhun' Activates 'Observation Lv.4'!]

He could tell because he was such a Killer King.

'Golden radiance of eyes.'

'Superior growth potential compared to 3rd round.'

'[Gate] that can be freely used.'

'The appearance is abnormal.'

A series of information filled the gaps in his mind. Information that was understood and information that was not understood were classified.

All of that happened in the blink of an eye, and Killer King came to a conclusion.

"What I'm talking about from now on is about a certain 'novel'."

Shin Yoosung looked back at Killer King.

Eyes flickering with faint agitation.

Killer King continued speaking without looking at Shin Yoosung.

"The main character of the novel had colleagues."

The roaring tail of a poisonous dragon flew nearby.

Killer King wrapped his arms around Cheon Inho, who was lying on the floor, and avoided it.

The tail of the poisonous dragon species began to rotate. The same pattern as the Fire Dragon species in the main story.

"Some of his colleagues were regressors."

Killer King gave a signal to his companions and started running counterclockwise, avoiding the poisonous dragon's tail.

"There were excellent swordsmen and great swordsmen. There were admirals who ruled the sea, and there were reincarnated people who could read fate."

Killer King looked behind him as he said those words.

His younger sister and Lee Dansu, who had trouble walking, were following him.

"There was also a boy who treated insects well."

Killer King raised his head calmly and finally looked at Shin Yoosung.

"There was also a girl who was good at handling animals."

Eyes with a faint sparkle.

Killer King said while looking into those eyes.

"As far as I know, the story is over."

"…"

"But why hasn't the girl left the story yet?"

Shin Yoosung didn't say anything. As if the answer was not allowed in this world.

The child simply held Cheon Inho's thin hand and repeated the same words.

"Ahjussi, wake up. Ahjussi!"

Killer King watched the scene silently, then turned her back and looked at his sister.

"Yerin. Analysis."

“It’s the same as the main story. It’s a deteriorated version of the dragon."

"Weakness."

"Because it is a poison attribute, earth attribute and fire are effective. All attacks that caused even a small amount of damage earlier were of the fire attribute."

"Goes to the fire attribute."

"Instead of inviting you, you have to get a red wreath."

"Fire resistance is also necessary."

"I have the resistance skill. My brother got the red wreath."

"For now, let’s move on to the next phase."

Shin Yoosung’s eyes widened as she watched the siblings having a quick conversation.

[Grade 5 monster 'Lesser Dragon Poisoner' prepares 'Death’s Hianhwa'.]

Poisoner, one of the poisonous dragons that had recovered its tail, roared into the air, and red flower buds began to bloom on the floor of the area.

The attack used by it in this round is Flame of the file.

On the other hand, the entire attack aircraft used by the poisonous dragon species was 'Hianhwa of Death'.

If it is similar to the development of the main story, this phase was an instant death.

Nevertheless, Killer King stepped forward without hesitation.

Shin Yoosung said as she grabbed Killer King’s wrist.

"Wait."

"I know you can kill that thing."

"…"

"But after killing that thing, will you be safe?"

Even the constellations in the sky do not dare to interfere with the early scenario.

If a miracle that is enough to defeat such a disaster is accomplished, no matter how divine Yoosoung is, she cannot be safe from the aftereffects.

Killer King silently released Shin Yoosung's hand and was about to reload his arrow.

"The main character of the novel."

A voice came out from Shin Yoosung's mouth.

Surprised, Killer King looked back.

So far, Shin Yoosung has not given any answers to his questions. Because probability did not permit that answer.

"He was always alone. Even though he had so many colleagues, he was always alone."

Cheez. A spark that bounces. Killer King looked at Shin Yoosung in silence.

He asked. Why is this story continuing? Shin Yoosung had just answered his question in her own way.

Shin Yoosung said with red eyes.

"So you can't do it alone."

Killer King nodded slowly and answered with a sigh.

"Don't worry."

Shin Yoosung knew a man who was good at making that kind of expression.

He was a shabby person compared to the terrible poisonous pain. A man so fragile that he feels as if he will fly if he gets hit with a single blow.

A lonely person fighting against the ending of a single world.

"To know the ending of this story."

Two people stood side by side next to the man.

"I am not alone."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 662 Episode 19 Reader (4)

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Ja Sungwoo had a good memory since he was young.

It was so good that he could completely remember the moment when his parents abandoned him and his younger sister in front of the orphanage when he was four years old—the snowy streets, his mother's expression, his younger sister crying, and the cold of the dawn that struck him every second.

These were memories he would like to forget if he could. Since his memories could not be erased, he decided to make them meaningless by accumulating more memories.

—You really like books. Are you going to be a writer when you grow up?

The words of the daycare teacher who was stroking his head.

—I'm just going to be a person who reads a lot of books.

He also remembered the expression the daycare teacher made right after hearing those words.

Read, read, read again.

While he was reading it like that, sometimes he would also read it to someone else.

—I have all the books.

His sister had no recollection of the time she was abandoned.

It could be because she was too young, or it could be because she was blind from a young age. Either way, Ja Sungwoo was a little jealous of his younger sister who couldn't remember what happened.

Maybe that's why he deliberately chose books that seemed boring to read to her.

—Literary magazine.

—Read it to me.

Looking back, it was his younger sister who made him read that novel.

He was reading books by his younger sister's favorite author as usual, but suddenly his younger sister said she wanted to read the author's new work.

So he looked up the author's new work on the daycare teacher's computer.

「Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint.」

It was a strange title.

The first web novel he read. He thought it was good because there was a lot of it. The more texts he reads, the more distant his childhood memories will become.

It was a novel he read with that in mind.

—Brother.

But when he came to his senses. He was reading the novel over and over again dozens of times.

—Why do you like that novel?

When his younger sister asked that question. Ja Sungwoo answered this way.

—No matter how much I read it, I don’t understand the ending.

All novels are fiction.

In other words, it is the author's lie.

Ja Sungwoo also knew.

He is not Kim Dokja. He is not even a 'fragment of Kim Dokja'. It makes no sense both probabilistically and chronologically.

Nevertheless, Ja Sungwoo often thought like that.

In fact, if there really is a 'past' that he cannot remember.

If there is a <Star Stream>, Yoo Joonghyuk, and Han Sooyoung somewhere in this universe, it is the story he forgot, the image he loved. Not his parents who abandoned him.

What is his origin? If only he existed there.

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."

Killer King Ja Sungwoo, who suddenly opened his eyes, analyzed the situation with his cold eyes. A world that only existed in print. The fiction that existed as a lie from the author unfolded vividly before his eyes.

「The Lesser Dragon roared into the air.」

The world he dreamed of has now become a reality.

[The phase 'heat' is beginning.]

He was confident that he understood that world better than the author who wrote it.

"Finding your footing."

The Disaster episode.

It was something he had already read a hundred times.

"The monster species has changed, but the scenario content has not. There will be a hidden piece that can activate the shield when the heat phase begins."

Poisonous lesser dragon.

It was a disaster that was well within the expected range.

"It’s over there."

Literature Girl 64 Cha Yerin found a foothold.

As the group stood on the scaffolding side by side, a series of messages appeared before their eyes.

[Hidden piece is activated.]

[Numerical steps are activated.]

[If the right number of people enters the platform, 'Absolute Shield' can be activated for 10 people.]

[When the number of people below or exceeding the number is on the scaffolding, the 'Absolute Shield' does not activate.]

The foothold the group found was '5'

Killer King looked at his companions.

'It’s me, Yerin, Lee Dansu, Shin Yoosung. There are a total of five, including Cheon Inho, who fainted.'

The scaffolding soon turned green.

['Absolute Shield' can be activated.]

In the distance, he could see the Avatars struggling to find their footing. Some of them even had flower buds blooming on the ground.

"What is this-"

Even before the incarnation finished speaking, the flower buds on the floor were in full bloom.

Killer King immediately activated his shield.

[Activate Absolute Shield!]

[Level 5 poisonous dragon species, Lesser Dragon Poisoner uses 'Death’s Hianflower'.]

A bunch of wildflowers in full bloom all at once. The green spores spread in an instant, leaving no trace of the labyrinth.

Flower buds sprouted from the spore-covered skin of the incarnations, and the dragon quickly shrunk.

"Keuyeok."

The mummified incarnations passed away one by one.

The spores of the wildflowers grown as fertilizer invaded the area.

The only safe place was where Absolute Shield was activated.

[The 'Absolute Shield' is released.]

['The Hianhwa of Death' disappears.]

In the empty space where the spores disappeared, the stems of dead plants and the incarnations that became corpses rolled around.

With a single attack, all the incarnations except them died.

It was a terrifying attack, but it could be easily avoided if he knew the pattern.

It was an attack.

The problem is that the 'number stepping stone' cannot be luckily matched forever.

The subtle smile of the intermediate dokkaebi floating in the air was the evidence.

If the number step '5' does not appear again next time, a casualty among the party members will arise.

[After 1 minute, the position of the footrest will be regenerated.]

In other words, they had to see the outcome before the next 'Annihilation' began.

"Jophiel."

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' looks at his incarnation.]

"Is it still possible to sponsor relics?"

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' replies that your rank is not yet sufficient.]

"In that case, I would like to receive divine protection and support."

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' demands payment.]

"I will hand over half of the shares of 'King's Tale' that I will acquire for the first time to <Eden>."

[Constellation 'The Commander of the Red Cosmos' accepts.]

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' grants 'Valkyrie's Protection'.]

Valkyrie's protection.

[Valkyrie's protection has been temporarily activated.]

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' adds that this protection can only be used in the beginning scenarios.]

Killer King felt a faint warmth spreading throughout his body.

An unmistakable 'fire attribute' buff.

He immediately took out a bright blue bead from his chest.

"I will exchange this for 'Red Wreaths'. You can use the exchange or go through 'Dokkaebi Bag'. As soon as possible. I will pay the fee."

As he took a breather in the center of the clearing, a poisonous dragon species looked back.

[The constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' accepts the incarnation's request.]

[5 items, Red Wreaths have been acquired!]

The poisonous dragon's tail, spinning brightly, swung towards them.

Killer King ran with his companions and threw the wreaths at his sister.

"Yerin!"

The key to this operation was his younger sister, Cha Yerin.

Cha Yerin immediately swallowed the wreaths. At the same time, a faint flame began to glow throughout her body.

She frowned slightly.

She ate as many as five pieces of red wreath, so his sister’s stomach must be boiling like hell.

"40 seconds," said Yerin.

This means that the limit time for dissipating heat through [fire resistance] is 40 seconds.

Killer King looked back at Lee Dansu.

"Now."

Lee Dansu, who was running on the right, nodded his head and pointed at the wall of the maze.

At the same time, black dots began to gather from somewhere around the bag.

The wheels were nothing special.

A swarm of cockroaches flew up like dust and stuck to the head of the poisonous dragon.

As if it was annoyed, the poisonous dragon sprayed radial breath into the air, and the bugs that were blocking its view melted away helplessly. The moment when the poisonous dragon snorted triumphantly and roared once again.

A white light flashed before his eyes.

The sharp claw tore off one of the poisonous dragon's eyes. It was Yerin's white and blue flag filled with the flames of a red wreath.

It was an effective blow, but it wasn't enough to defeat the dragon.

In the main story, Kim Dokja received the help of the master of Unbreakable Faith in order to defeat the disaster.

The fortress effect and stigma [Song of the Sword] were activated.

However, for Cha Yerin, there was neither 'Unbreakable Faith' nor [Song of the Sword].

'This is [Valkyrie's remorse] that I received to replace it.'

As Killer King stretched out his hand towards his sister, the effect of the blessings flowing from his body transferred to Cha Yerin.

It was the effect of [Heartless], a dedicated skill that allows them to share buffs with each other.

[Baekjeonggi, Valkyrie's Protection, and even the supernormal ability of 'Red Wreath'.]

Nevertheless, the attack power was still insufficient.

Even if it were Kim Dokja who was here, this combination alone would not be able to ward off disaster.

However, the person who was there was not Kim Dokja.

"Go, Yerin."

His younger sister, Cha Yerin, is different from Kim Dokja. Unlike Kim Dokja, who was not talented in skills, Cha Yerin was full of talent.

The mastery of the skills she learned rose quickly, and her overall ability level was higher than that of Kim Dokja.

[Incarnation 'Lee Seyeon' activates Skill 'Battle Action Mode'!]

A controller appeared in front of Killer King.

Memories of daycare came to mind. Memories of fighting with kids over the controller to play a game.

Killer King won the fight and held this controller longer than anyone else.

"Dark Spinning Breaker."

[The advanced command was successfully activated!]

Cha Yerin's claws, burning dark red, quickly fertilized the entire body of the poisonous dragon.

Quad deud deuk!

The poisonous dragon's thick carapace could not withstand Cha Yerin's attack strengthened by [Battle Action Mode].

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is amazed by the wit of the incarnations!]

[The constellation 'The Prisoner of the Golden Headband' admires the power of the incarnation 'Lee Seyeon'.]

[A few constellations are donating 500 coins to incarnation Lee Seyeon!]

Exclamations of constellations erupted from everywhere. Killer King watched his sister's actions while holding the heated controller.

Just a little more, just a little more—

And.

[The fighting action mode is canceled.]

[Overall review: Linkage score 91 points! Are you an aspiring professional gamer?]

Finally, the fighting action mode was released and Cha Yerin's movements became sluggish.

Then, the large body of the poisonous dragon species collapsed to the floor.

Joy went up his spine. He did it. His operation was successful.

However.

Purr.

The next moment, the venomous dragon species suddenly stood up and started devouring the surrounding plant corpses.

He had a feeling something was wrong.

'Why?'

Poisoner, a poisonous dragon species, should have died in the attack just now. Everything was under his calculation.

The poisonous dragon species that ate the flowers was recovering some vitality at the end of its death.

Killer King instinctively started running towards his sister.

"Yerin!"

Cha Yerin, who mustered all the magic of her body, moved once again. Although it was not as bad as when she activated [combat action mode], her claws were steadily accumulating blows to the poisonous dragon species.

However, the poisonous dragon roared into the air, not caring about the small wounds.

[Level 5 poisonous dragon species 'Lesser Dragon Poisoner' prepares 'Bamboo Dragon’s Hianhwa'.]

Red flower buds were starting to appear on the tropical floor.

"Yerin! Come back!"

Cha Yerin did not stop her attacks. With her determination to defeat the poisonous dragon species without fail, she continued her attacks while staggering.

Killer King hugged his sister's waist and fell behind her.

Cha Yerin said, struggling.

"Let go"

Now, blood poured out of Yerin’s mouth. The flame of the red wreath had burned her insides.

Cha Yerin could no longer fight.

Killer King said this even though he knew that fact.

"You can kill him in the next phase. Just be patient. There’s still a chance."

Cha Yerin, who spit something out of her mouth, fell limply in his arms. Four undigested red wreaths fell to the floor with sparking flames.

Killer King thought as he picked up the red wreath.

His sister couldn't fight, but even the poisonous dragon species was now at its limit.

All he has to do is deliver the final blow.

He could probably do it on his own.

There are still Valkyrie's relics and red wreaths.

He just has to endure it this one time.

[Numerical scaffolding is created.]

Luckily, a platform was created nearby.

Killer King immediately checked the number on the footrest.

And he froze in his place in a daze.

4.

There were no additional footholds anywhere to be seen.

Killer King looked at the faces of the remaining people. Cheon Inho was collapsed, Shin Yoosung was taking care of him, and…

"Brother."

His staggering sister shook her head. As if she knew what he was thinking.

Killer King laid Cha Yerin down and then slowly stood up.

"Oppa, please."

"It’s okay."

Killer King looked back at the poisonous dragon species.

The flower buds on the floor were increasing. The attack would begin soon.

The floor covering had not been activated yet.

What was the problem? Was it because his strategy was sloppy? Or was there a sentence he couldn't read? The number on the step is 4. And the number of people left now is 5.

'I am.'

Kim Dokja would have moved forward without hesitation.

But Killer King did not give up easily. Why? He knows even without asking.

'Because he is not Kim Dokja.'

A field of wildflowers filled the floor.

"Brother."

He wanted to become Yoo Joonghyuk, he thought like that. He wanted to become a reader. The moment he took a step forward, he thought like that.

[Numerical footpad is activated.]

The scaffolding turned green.

[You can activate 'Absolute Shield'.]

He didn't know what had happened. He was still in the scaffolding.

Nevertheless, the scaffolding was activated. That means.

[Someone other than him became Kim Dokja.]

When he raised his head, he saw the face of a blind man.

He was probably the person who was the furthest from Kim Dokja here.

A man who always wandered around looking for his daughter, and who only read 'Omniscient Reader' once.

"Don’t feel guilty."

Killer King could tell what he was thinking.

Lee Dansu had already lost his eyesight, and his body was almost destroyed. Even if he uses the 'Spirit of Elaine Forest', his body will not recover.

"I have nothing to lose now."

Killer King was unable to catch Lee Dansu, who was walking sloppily.

Lee Dansu’s choice was right.

Everyone except him were talented people who were absolutely necessary to see the end of this damned world.

With nothing to lose, it was right for him to go.

'But, if it were Kim Dokja, he might have said this.'

At that moment, a thought crossed Killer King’s mind.

His eyes gave off a dazzling light.

[Eyes of sin.]

Jophiel's Stigmata. Killer King, who measures the 'sin karma' of all incarnations, was momentarily dazed after checking Lee Dansu's soul.

A pure white soul, as if it were wearing a white coat. Killer King had never seen such a soul before.

'One thing, there might be a way for him to live!'

But Killer King couldn't immediately think of the method.

It was natural. Because it was a sentence that had not been written yet.

It was the writer's job, not the reader's, to write the next sentence.

[Stage 3 of 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is being activated.]

So, me.

"The scenario isn’t over yet!"

I thought as I looked at the man named Dansu walking towards the poisonous dragon.

There is a way for no one to die.

But if I use this method.

[Level 5 poisonous dragon species, Lesser Dragon Poisoner, uses 'Death’s Blood'.]

Lee Dansu must die 'once'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 663 Episode 20 Reader (5)

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Noh Gyeonghwan moved forward one step at a time. Since he couldn't see in front of him, the world's scenery was complete darkness.

Noh Gyeonghwan muttered as he stretched deeper into the darkness.

"What is the scene like now?"

He didn't ask expecting an answer. But someone answered.

—It’s a flower arrangement, ahjussi.

The sound was so distant that he couldn't tell who it belonged to.

Noh Gyeonghwan heard that voice and imagined an invisible landscape. Then, one by one, flowers bloomed in the darkness.

Red marigolds blooming everywhere.

It was the flower that would kill him.

Noh Gyeonghwan said:

"It’s beautiful."

Noh Gyeonghwan thought about his wife who died after being hit by a meteorite.

He thinks about his wife who died in the flower garden and he dies.

If his life were a novel, wouldn't this be the place where his last sentence would be written?

Novel.

Noh Gyeonghwan recalled his daughter’s favorite novel.

He wishes this was also a story. He hopes someday his daughter reads this story and laughs. He wishes he could say something like that to his daughter.

See, this dad also appears in your favorite novel.

Noh Gyeonghwan smiled bitterly.

Jiyoon was probably dead.

He would have died in this life, just like his wife did.

He thought about his daughter's last days.

How painful was it? How lonely she must have been.

Noh Gyeonghwan gathered his strength once again and took his steps. Now he will soon be able to meet his wife and daughter.

To do so, he must end the story of Lee Dansu, not the human Noh Gyeonghwan.

'I am Lee Dansu.'

The name he received in the new world. What kind of life did the original owner of this body live?

He does not know.

However, his body was now at its limits and his consciousness continued to blur. It must be because too much blood was shed.

[The power of the star gem strengthens your body!]

If there weren't one star gem left, it wouldn't have been surprising if he didn’t collapse right away in this state.

The sound of the Lesser Dragon's breathing was getting closer.

A dizzying flowery scent reached the tip of his nose.

Lee Dansu finally remembered the name of one man.

'Inho-ssi, I'm sorry.'

And that moment.

The voice became clearer.

—I see you can hear me now.

The voice that said earlier that this place was a flower garden. Lee Dansu knew the owner of that voice.

"Inho-ssi?"

I answered.

—Yes, it’s me.

Lee Dansu looked around even though he knew he was blind. The man’s voice was trembling.

"How did you wake up? You shouldn't be here. If you don't get back on the scaffolding-"

—I am safe. The important thing now is you.

"I’m done now."

The voice of someone who has already let go of life.

Lee Dansu's eyes were blind, and every part of his body was necrotic. The muscles in his limbs fell into clumps.

But the reason he wants to give up on life may not be because of his crippled body.

"Why is the world killing my family?"

I didn't know what to say.

What would Yoo Joonghyuk have said?

「"As soon as the scenario begins, there is a dead boy. Are you more unhappy? Or is the boy more unfortunate? What is the meaning of fighting over misfortune in this world?"」

What would Han Sooyoung say?

「"All misfortunes are ordinary. It looks special because it was captured in a story."」

But I couldn't talk like them.

Those words weren't what he needed.

"I don’t want to live anymore."

The reason I want Lee Dansu to live longer here is probably just my greed for liking him.

—Ahjussi.

I know. Even if he survives here, his misfortune will not go away.

He will have to endure life.

He will have to live in a world without his wife and daughter.

What does it mean to him? Can I make that meaning? How dare I do something like that?

Even though I was thinking about that, I couldn't suppress this greed.

「I want to write a novel.」

Sitting in an unknown theater, I wanted to show the next story to readers who, like me, were hoping that the man would survive. I started writing sentences.

「What kind of person was my father?」

Lee Dansu trembled with excitement and looked up into empty space.

「My mom died after being hit by a meteorite and my dad got cancer.」

The man's lips closing again and again.

「Are we a cursed family?」

Even a man who can't see anything will hear that sentence.

"Who just said that…"

The uncle stuttered in disbelief and then he asked:

"Is it Jiyoon?"

—Yes.

"Jiyoon, is she alive?"

I hesitated to answer.

If I answer honestly, the truth will take away his last hope.

But if I tell a lie, is it a lie that can be forgiven?

I blinked slowly.

And I thought about a person's heart, not about truth or lies.

「"Please save my father, Kim Dokja."」

A daughter's wish for her father to survive. I thought of a sentence that would represent that feeling.

—Yes.

This world is the <Star Stream>.

A world created by the author, readers, and protagonist together.

A world where it is possible for dead people to come back to life, to go against time, and to be reborn as a different person.

At least in this world.

-Yes, she is alive.

This is not a lie.

—For that to happen, you must survive first.

Spores were spreading rapidly in the air. It will now take less than 30 seconds for spores to cover the entire area.

"B-but how…"

The voice of an impatient man.

I possessed the man's body as if I would jump into the ocean behind him if I calmly took a breath.

[Stage 3 of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is strongly activated!]

The man’s eyes shone brightly. In the place where his eyes disappeared, pupils formed from clusters of light appeared.

"I can see it!"

It was my eyes.

—Run!

Ahjussi and I ran to avoid the spores. I continued running, being careful not to step on the flower buds on the floor.

—Coat!

The man picked up the coat that had fallen on the floor. It was my white coat that fell off while dodging the attack of the poisonous species earlier.

—There’s a brown bottle in my inner pocket!

The man immediately found the item I mentioned.

Sideuk Kobulo's Horn Powder.

A consumable item with a poison neutralizing effect.

—Spores ahead! Dodge to the right! Pick up a book next to it!

There was something that looked like a small booklet rolling around on the floor where I pointed. It was an item dropped by the men of the king who died earlier.

[Item 'Donguibogam Miscellaneous Soldiers' was acquired.]

The groups gathered here are probably the ones who cleared the 5-person dungeon 'Donguibogam's Field'.

[Item 'Donguibogam Bedding' was acquired.]

A total of 9 books by Donguibogam fell on the floor.

[Item 'Donguibogam'. The effect of 'incomplete version' is in effect.]

And Donguibogam is an item that activates poison resistance when you collect more than 8 pieces.

[Your body has temporarily gained the Poison Resistance ability.]

I could feel the man's breathing getting easier. But this is nothing more than buying time.

Even if 'Sideuk Kobulo's Horn Powder' and 'Donguibogam' create synergy, not even 30 trillion antibodies will be able to withstand these spores.

The man's body was turning brown after being touched by the spores.

Grrrr…

At that moment, the dragon, who sensed something unusual, also looked this way.

An additional phase is triggered when the man does not die despite its attack.

The poisonous dragon species let out a harsh cry into the air and let out its breath.

"Hey, Inho-ssi."

The man's complexion turned pale as he watched his breath fall like acid rain.

I reassured the man.

—It's okay. Run, hurry!

"Can I continue living?"

—We must meet Jiyoon again!

The man gasped without answering. That short silence was telling me.

Ahjussi already knows everything.

"Even if I survive, I will continue to be a burden to Inho-ssi."

A burden. Lee Dansu thought of himself that way.

—Ahjussi.

Killer King looked at him with [eyes of sin].

It is said that Lee Dansu had a pure white soul, as if he were wearing a white coat.

I could read the footsteps of the pure white soul.

「"Could you please tell me how to catch bugs?"」

A person who has completed 'Proof of Worth' by killing bugs on the subway.

「"Do you really have to kill others?"」

Lee Dansu, alone, defended his beliefs in a scenario where everyone was killing each other.

「"I won’t kill you. I won’t kill you."」

A person who ate the 'star jewel' and became a monster, but did not kill anyone in the end.

—None of us lived like you.

In this world, one person's life soon becomes a story.

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' looks at incarnation 'Lee Dansu'.]

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' watches incarnation 'Lee Dansu'.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' supports the history of incarnation 'Lee Dansu'.]

However, in order to prove the story, a 'qualification' is needed.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' nods.]

A 'qualification' to prove that ahjussi’s story is worth recording.

That qualification was rolling around on the floor.

—Run! Pick it up! Hurry!

With my shout, the man picked up the 'brown flag' that had fallen on the floor.

A soft light shone all over Lee Dansu’s whole body.

[Incarnation 'Lee Dansu' took the 'brown flag'.]

[The King's Road begins!]

Acidic liquid fell from the air and poured down on the man's head. An attack that cannot be neutralized even with 'Donguibogam' or 'Sideuk Kobulo's Horn Powder'.

[The shield is activated by the effect of the 'brown flag'.]

A shield stretched out in the air blocked the acid breath.

I quickly looked around.

A total of eight flags fell to the ground. They were all dropped by dead kings.

In order to complete 'King’s Path' in this world line, we must achieve the 'Black Flag'.

—Pick it all up!

Every time a new flag is picked up, the color of the man's flag starts to change.

Dark brown, heat purple, purple, dark purple, and-

The man's body, caught on a stone, rolled on the floor. The sound of a flower bud bursting as it is crushed. The thick spores began to stick to the man's entire body.

"Ah."

Flowers grew on the man's skin. The wildflowers were blooming continuously, giving off a strong scent. The man’s magic began to disappear rapidly.

[Incarnation 'Lee Dansu' achieved the 'Black Flag'.]

The sound of breathing coming slowly.

I could feel the man’s fear.

Now even ahjussi knew.

What will happen from now on?

And what was my plan?

[The key conditions for 'The King's Road' are unlocked.]

I don't know whether this operation will succeed or not.

"Thank you."

The man covered in red petals smiled as if he knew how I felt.

「This is a path that only Lee Dansu can take in this world. And for this method to succeed, ahjussi must die once.」

Death.

I don't know what that is. Maybe I don't even want to know.

Is that something that can be 'experienced'? What happens after you go through that?

—Ahjussi, don't worry.

No one knows that except Kim Dokja.

—I will be with you.

We will soon find out.

"Friend."

With the man's last words, my vision darkened completely.

A pitch-black void has arrived. A phrase with nothing written in it.

I called ahjussi over and over again. But Lee Dansu had no answer.

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint has an abnormal reaction!]

Am I alive now or am I dead?

If it's none of the two.

Am I just looking at a huge wall?

I fumbled along the endless wall, searching like a madman for print that I could read.

And the next moment.

Black. With that feeling, the darkness sucked me in. The surroundings became brighter. I was in the labyrinth again.

[A new king was born.]

[You made a decisive contribution to the birth of a new king.]

[The <Star Stream> reassesses your story.]

[A new 'loss' is recorded on the 'Final Wall'.]

A dazzling light was shining through the fluttering red flower petals.

Inside, the body of Lee Dansu was being reconstructed.

「Now, it was the moment when a new 'King of No Killing' was born.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 664 Episode 20 Reader (6)

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The King of No Killing.

In the original work, only Kim Dokja and Selena Kim had this characteristic of a 'king'.

「Dansu ahjussi became the 'King of No Killing'.」

Dansu ahjussi has the characteristics that Kim Dokja had in the original work.

I was extremely happy for ahjussi’s survival, but at the same time, I felt empty and lonely.

What is Kim Dokja doing now?

Is he standing in that snowy field?

Or somewhere I don't know, still reading this story?

If he looks at this story now, what will he say?

"Wake up! It's not over yet!"

The man who was awoken by Killer King's cry opened his eyes.

Killer King suddenly ran over, hugged the man's waist and rolled over.

With a loud noise, the sole of the venomous dragon's foot hit the spot where the man was and crushed it.

"Hey, Inho-ssi! Where are you, Inho-ssi-"

The man looked for me, but I couldn’t answer.

[First-person perspective cannot be activated on this character.]

Perhaps because of the septum from before, it was now impossible to transfer to the man. From now on, Dansu ahjussi must overcome this alone.

"Cheon Inho hasn’t woken up yet. We have to figure it out ourselves."

No, not alone.

Because there are now three complete readers of Kim Dokja’s story.

As if representing my thoughts, Killer King looked around at his companions and opened his mouth.

"We are not Kim Dokja, but we at least have one of Kim Dokja’s attributes."

Killer King added as he glanced at his younger sister and Dansu ahjussi.

"Yerin is [Baekcheonganggi]. You are the [Immortal King]. I have Kim Dokja’s cool-headedness and intelligence."

The last one was a bit strange, but Killer King is definitely the only one I can trust now.

"You can still do it."

The condition of the group was a mess.

Cha Yerin, who had vomited blood several times, could barely stand, and Lee Dansu, who had just been revived, was still unable to come to his senses.

Still, they didn't give up.

"That monster has already recovered a lot of its stamina."

After catching her breath, Yerin opened her mouth.

Could it be that eating the petals of the marigold flower earlier had an effect? The condition of toxicosis, which seemed like she would die soon, had improved considerably.

[After 1 minute, the position of the footrest will be regenerated]

Yerin bit her lip as if she was angry.

"It’s hard for us alone."

Lee Dansu cannot run in one direction, and Cha Yerin can no longer use the [Battle action mode].

Now the only person I can trust is Killer King.

However, Killer King's stamina was also greatly reduced, and he did not have enough strength to finish the fight properly.

"No, there is still a chance."

I also had the same thoughts as Killer King. There is still one more chance left for the party.

The evidence from before was the intermittent vibrations beneath my feet.

The poisonous dragon species that was glaring at my companions also looked around with wary eyes, as if they had noticed it.

The vibration echoed once again.

Then, with a sound as if the edge of the maze was collapsing, a monster reminiscent of a black bull appeared.

[The 6th grade guardian species, 'Labyrinth Sentinel', has appeared!]

The monster with the face of a minotaur and a huge execution axe in one hand was the very monster that Bang Cheolsoo had warned us about before entering the labyrinth.

Judging by the energy it gives off, it is a monster that ranks high among level 6 monsters.

Any number of incarnations would be cut in two just by being touched by that axe.

It was obvious why it had been called here.

'The full flute of provocation'.

An item that provokes all types of monsters.

The grass flute I used earlier even summoned the watchman of the labyrinth at the edge of the maze.

Goooooooo!

The Labyrinth Sentinel let out a harsh roar and broke through the barrier of the closed area.

[6th grade Guardian Bell, 'Labyrinth Sentinel' has recognized the disaster!]

[5th grade poisonous dragon species, 'Lesser Dragon Poisoner' recognized 'Labyrinth Sentinel'.]

The eyes of the two monsters became intertwined in the air.

One side is a fresh grade 6 type. And on the other side a grade 5, that has a deep wound.

In the moment of tension, it was the labyrinth sentinel who rushed in first.

The huge execution ax dug into the poisonous dragon's wing scales, and at the same time, the poisonous dragon's elongated neck bit into the watchman's forearm.

Coo coo coo coo!

The two monsters grabbed each other and rolled around in a cloud of dust.

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is curious about the clash between the monsters.]

[A few constellations are amazed at your wit that made the war happen.]

[Some constellations who like monsters' wills sponsor you with 500 coins.]

Killer King said in a heavy voice.

"It bought us some time. But the dragon will win in the end."

In fact, the monsters' grappling was quickly gaining momentum.

The entire body of the labyrinth sentinel, who seemed to have an advantage at first glance, was instantly covered in the claw marks of the poisonous dragon species, and soon after, green fluid oozed from the wounds.

The poison of the poisonous dragon species began to eat away at the sentinel's entire body.

"The 'Annihilation' will be activated soon."

Even if the Labyrinth Sentinel holds out, the annihilation will activate after one minute.

In other words, the party must somehow take advantage of this opportunity to defeat the disaster.

Magical power began to gather in Killer King's bowgun.

The supernormal abilities of 'Valkyrie's Protection' and 'Red Wreath' were fused, and the tip of the arrowhead gave off a red glow.

"All you have to do is hit this one shot."

The three began to approach while the two monster species were fighting.

Their goal is to finish off both monsters with low health at the same time.

And I was watching everything from behind their backs, unable to do anything.

I want to see you a little more.

Even if I can't help their fight, I want to continue to see it, if only to watch it from afar.

「Perhaps Kim Dokja also looks at the world with this feeling.」

But now I had little time left.

The time limit for '3rd person observer view' is approaching.

My body convulsed as I lay on the floor.

A body that has ingested six star gems and is barely able to suppress its transformation into a monster.

When [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] is over, I will be swept up in [madness] again.

Even if the dragon dies and the sentinel dies, the fight will not end.

This fight will only end when someone collects the '7 Star Jewels'.

"Ahjussi."

I looked back for a moment. Shin Yoosung was talking as if she could see my soul.

"Can I help you?"

The golden glow flowing through Shin Yoosung's eyes.

[Incarnation 'Shin Yoosung' is activating 'multi-species communication'.]

"Say it, ahjussi."

Shin Yoosung's small hand was on my chest. Shin Yoosung's intentions were being conveyed to me through a faint light.

"If you say one word, I will kill them all."

Now I know too.

Shin Yusung can really do that. Because, [now this 'Shin Yoosung' does not exist in this world line.]

Shin Yoosung, who has now been possessed in the 41st round, is the Shin Yoosung from <Kim Dokja Company> that I know.

But why is 'Shin Yoosung' trying to help me?

'No.'

Shin Yoosung's body trembled.

"Why? Aren't they important to you?"

'I don't want to see you die here.'

I remember every sentence of this story. I know better than anyone else what kind of place the <Star Stream> is and what the aftereffects of probability are.

In the novel, Kim Dokja goes against probability several times and withstands the odds.

But even after Kim Dokja did such a ridiculous thing, he was able to survive.

The reason he did it was because he was the main character.

「If Shin Yoosung uses her power now, Shin Yoosung will definitely disappear.」

'Please take out the pills in your pocket.'

Shin Yoosung took out a golden pill from her pocket.

It was a medicinal herb obtained as a reward after defeating Yongdu Ark at Seoul Station.

"Would you like me to feed you?"

Shin Yoosung crushed the pills with her small hands and put them in my mouth.

Let the pharmacological action of the hwandan occur. My dull face became a little brighter.

My body is now at its limit.

Even if it was this, it was impossible to suddenly improve my state.

But it might give me some energy.

Shin Yoosung asked with a trembling voice.

"Ahjussi. We're not going to fight, right? You can't do it in this state. Your body is already gone."

Then, a sound was heard and the labyrinth sentinel was seen falling in the center of the clearing.

The battle between the monsters is over and the winner has been decided.

The poisonous dragon that bit off the sentinel's body roared into the air.

[Level 5 special species, 'Lesser Dragon Poisoner' prepares to attack!]

And the group moved.

Cha Yerin, who had squeezed out the last of her magical power, cut the Poisoner's ankles with [White Blue Steel].

Lee Dansu who activated [Taming] cleared the cockroaches and disrupted the special attack's vision once again.

Killer King aimed his bowgun at the Lesser Dragon, who lost its balance and collapsed.

"Finish."

Red Wreath and an arrow wrapped with the Valkyries' supernormal abilities. At the tip of the arrowhead was the 503rd unit that Jophiel was proud of.

An arrow fired leaving a red solid line.

As if waiting for the attack, the poisonous dragon's head was tilted at a strange angle.

Killer King expected even that.

"Scatter away."

The arrowhead exploded right in front of the dragon's head, and the 503rd unit dispersed.

Unit 503, which was fired like a grenade, dug into the dragon's wounds with fire-attribute energy.

Push shoo shoo shoot!

Drops of green blood burst out like a fountain from the dragon's entire body. The poisonous dragon let out a painful cry.

However, even after receiving the attack, the poisonous dragon did not fall down.

"...Was it not enough?"

I realized how amazing Kim Dokja was when he caught the lesser dragon. Kim Dokja hunted it alone, a disaster that could not be caught even if all of them gathered together.

"Everyone get back!"

As the breath poured out from the poisonous dragon, Killer King also vomited blood from his mouth. Undigested red wreaths littered the floor.

[The 5th level poisonous dragon, 'Lesser Dragon Poisoner' activates 'Death's Blood'!]

"Find the rash! Quick!"

Flowers began to bloom on the floor.

A hint of despair flashed in Killer King's eyes.

Even if they survived this turn, there was no chance for the party to win now.

Even Dansu ahjussi's characteristics, Cha Yerin's [Battle Action Mode], and Killer King's stigmata cannot kill that disaster.

However.

「"Hakhyun."」

I might be able to do it.

「"No matter what, this time tell me a happy story."」

Kim Dokja said so.

A story that makes me happy.

What do I want to talk about?

「"Well done, Heewon."」

Is that a story for the 'extras' who were ignored in the main story?

「"Someone died. Someone died because of this story."」

Or is it a story about as many people as possible surviving?

「"I will prevent the destruction of this world."」

Or, is it a story that does not destroy the 41st turn?

「"Are you really Cheon Inho?"」

I don't know.

Why and for whom am I continuing to tell this story?

「"Why did you decide to write a novel?"」

Someone's voice suddenly came to mind.

That wasn't my memory.

A memory that seems to have flowed from a source older than me.

In that memory, Han Sooyoung was speaking.

「"I don't know. I'll know when I'm done."」

I slowly opened my fist.

Shin Yoosung realized what I was trying to do and grabbed my wrist.

"Ahjussi, stop. Right now…"

With the sound of tsk tsk tsk, the golden light in Shin Yoosung's eyes went out.

In the end, the <Star Stream> intervened. It was expected.

It was unusual that a strong being like Shin Yoosung intervened in the early part of the scenario in the form of 'possession'.

I muttered to myself towards the fallen Shin Yoosung.

'Thank you.'

Shin Yoosung did her job well enough.

From now on, it was up to me.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.9' is activated!]

'Wake up, Cheon Inho.'

Currently, I have activated [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]. Although I am chained in a soul state, it is possible to use some skills.

Tsutsutsu.

My body stretched out—Cheon Inho's fingers twitched.

'Wake up. Right now.'

[Incite is a skill that moves the target's unconsciousness.]

In that case, my body may be able to move even without my consciousness.

[The power of the 'star jewel' erodes your body.]

[' Monsterization' occurs.]

['Stage 6 of Madness' is encroaching on you.]

Because my soul was outside my body, I was able to move my body without being affected by [Madness].

Cheon Inho's body staggered and he stood up. However, Cheon Inho did not take a step straight away. It was as if it was resisting my will.

The pure power of [Incite] alone was not enough. So I decided to do what I always do.

[The sub-skill, 'Sentence Enhancement' is activated!]

[You can enter your actions.]

[The actions you enter will be reinforced.]

[The current enhancement level is level 1.]

[You can increase the reinforcement level by investing stock probability.]

[Current probability: 480.]

Writing sentences.

「Cheon Inho stood up from the floor.」

[10 probability is consumed.]

「The power of 'six star jewels' rose from Cheon Inho's whole body.」

[10 probability is consumed.]

「Cheon Inho began to stagger and move.」

Every time I added a single sentence, my head felt like it was going to explode.

I don't know how long the [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] state can continue. So I had to get the job done before my body woke up and before I fully regained consciousness.

「Only, Cheon Inho's body was falling apart little by little as he ran with the goal of killing the poisonous dragon species. Signs of becoming a monster appeared and muscles exploded in various places.」

I heard people around me shouting when they found me.

I ignored it and kept moving.

「Cheon Inho risked his life.」

What happens to a soul that loses a body to return to?

Maybe I, too, will go to that theater like other readers.

Or, it may literally become infuriating.

I was scared, but not as scared as I used to be. It may be because I had a glimpse of 'death' with Lee Dansu.

I could see the group finding a foothold in the distance.

A man wearing a white coat was shouting at me.

Ahjussi was not Kim Dokja.

Killer King too. Cha Yerin was also not Kim Dokja.

But if they all work together, they will be able to do what Kim Dokja can do.

They will be able to do things that I cannot do.

「They will see the end of this world.」

My body, which had broken through the rushing breath of the poisonous dragon head on, threw out its fist.

The mighty power of 6 star jewels burrowed into the poisonous dragon's chest.

「Cheon Inho thought.」

I knew it instinctively. Now I only have one sentence to write. Probability cannot bear any more sentences.

And the words to use were already decided.

「It's over.」

A probability that you risk your life for.

If this is the case, the <Star Stream> will be satisfied with the story.

[The constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' sighs.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' cries out!]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' cannot take his eyes off you!]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' turns his gaze.]

[Many constellations are truly surprised by your choice.]

If I go back to the snowy field, will I be able to tell Kim Dokja?

「It's over.」

This is him in my story.

「The end.」

For a moment, it felt like time stopped. The surrounding scenery was turning colorless. And.

「The end.」

I closed my eyes.

「It's not the end.」

Something strange was happening.

Someone in front of my eyes.

「It's not the end.」

…was correcting my sentences.

I looked at that sentence and repeated it blankly.

It's not the end.

[Someone edited your sentence.]

[Someone shares your probability.]

Only then did I realize what had happened.

「"But, author. I know this is a meta novel."」

A memory came to mind amidst the throbbing headache.

「"Do readers really want to become Kim Dokja? Isn't that just the writer's greed as a 'writer'?"」

In that memory, she was looking at the manuscript I had written.

「"So, my opinion as a reader."」

Maybe someone who understands this story better than me.

「"As expected, Kim Dokja must be revived."」

My editor.

「"The Kim Dokja we know."」

['Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is unlocked.]

With terrible pain, my soul was sucked back into Cheon Inho's body.

My heart was beating rapidly, and my mind, swept away by the effects of [madness], swayed precariously like a sailboat on the waves.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' looks to you.]

With deep breathing, the terrible pain subsided little by little. Someone was alleviating my pain.

Who is it? I can't see their face.

"Author."

However, someone was holding me in their arms and talking. I heard that voice in my consciousness that was gradually becoming distant.

"Write again."

Yes, I will. I answered.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 665 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (1)

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「"Why is Joonghyuk-ssi so harsh to Anna?"」

Lee Seolhwa asked in passing. It was a question that normally would not be asked. Because she knows very well how much Yoo Joonghyuk hates Anna Croft.

Still, she wanted to ask today.

Maybe it's because tomorrow is the final battle of the 'Holy Demon War'.

After tomorrow, Yoo Joonghyuk might be alone again.

"How about getting along with Anna?"

"She betrayed me."

"It was in an old round."

"She took over the memories from the last rounds."

"Didn't she just receive memories? Anna in this round didn't experience it herself."

The 'Anna Croft' of this round was not the 'Anna Croft' of the last round.

She just read the memories of the last rounds as if she were reading a novel.

Is it right for Anna Croft to receive the wrath of Yoo Joonghyuk?

"She went through the last round."

Lee Seolhwa closed her mouth for a moment.

Normally, the conversation would have stopped at this point. No matter what anyone says, Yoo Joonghyuk was a part time of 'regression'.

"In the last round, was it really Yoo Joonghyuk? This Yoo Joonghyuk is different from 'Yoo Joonghyuk' of the last round. Lee Seolhwa' from the previous round is different, just as this round's story is different."

Every human being is defined by the world around him.

Whether it's the 1,600th or 1,700th, he was still called 'Yoo Joonghyuk', but the meaning behind that name changed every time.

She was surprised.

This is because the people in rounds 1,600 and 1,700 are different people.

People with different memories, different experiences, and different times spent with them.

Because the world around him has changed, Yoo Joonghyuk is also a different person from the last round.

That is what Lee Seolhwa meant. Now let's get away from the past. Stop now and release the curse you have placed on yourself.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at the sky without answering. Lee Seolhwa also looked at the sky with him.

The deep and distant <Star Stream>.

A world where everything under the sky becomes a story.

When she glanced at Yoo Joonghyuk's profile, he seemed lonely, sad, and maybe he understood everything.

He is a man who has lived one story for a very long time.

At that moment, Lee Seolhwa realized.

Yoo Joonghyuk is the only force; everything else is just a phenomenon.

Lee Seolhwa, Lee Hyunsung, and Lee Jihye. All of his other companions are nothing more than one line of sentences written and erased in this repeated story.

"Before and even now, I am 'Yoo Joonghyuk'."

Hearing Yoo Joonghyuk's words, Lee Seolhwa opened her mouth slightly.

His name is not his own.

Because someone calls him Yoo Joonghyuk, he becomes Yoo Joonghyuk.

"It will continue to be Yoo Joonghyuk in the future."

Calling his own name.

It was about remembering the people who called his name.

In order not to leave the people he met as phenomena, to remember the meaning in that name.

[The story of eternal immortality is dreaming.]

And unfortunately, by saying that name, he will once again become the protagonist of the story.

A light was shining in the distance. Beyond the beam of light that erased the pitch-black night, Seongyun's army was approaching.

Lee Seolhwa watched the scene and asked.

"Are you going to come look for me in the next round?"

Yoo Joonghyuk silently searched the wind speed and took out the attack and defense unit.

The weapon left behind by his teacher. It was an item that had never been used in this round.

Yoo Joonghyuk held the end of a gombangdae in his mouth and let out his words as if smoking light smoke.

"Of course."

「—Three ways to survive in a ruined world.」

---

Tyrant King Jung Yonghu is a member of the Misreading association.

His hard disk contained dozens of fantasy novels, and the novels he had collected were the very history of his illegal activities.

He shared and re-shared files without any guilt.

Of course, there were times when he also bought books. He wanted to produce text by scanning or typing.

He knew that his actions violated copyright law. But he doesn't know anything about copyright law. After all, he was the one who purchased the book, so he is entitled to use its contents.

He thought so.

[Activates the exclusive skill 'Illegal Library'.]

His long history of illegal activities greatly helped him survive in this world.

There were thousands of fantasy novels in his head, and 'Ways of Survival', which was the basis of this world, was a world like a compilation of fantasy clichés. Whenever something happened, he took out the novels he had read illegally and reviewed them, and as a result, he was more knowledgeable than anyone else. He quickly achieved the qualifications to be a king and was crowned one of the 'Seven Kings of Seoul'.

"Is everyone gathered?"

The black flag fluttering behind his back proved his qualifications.

Jung Yonghu slowly turned his gaze and looked at the National Palace Museum.

Inside there lies the fatal accident site they were looking for.

"Why don’t you wait a little longer and go in? Are you planning to rush in now?"

The King of Assassins next to him let out a voice filled with concern.

"We still don’t know how the situation inside has developed. Since the 'disaster' has been unleashed, it must have become hell. We should send a scouting party to find out the situation inside first."

"Everyone would be dead. Unless Kim Dokja is inside."

Kim Dokja.

After hearing those words, the King of Assassins made an uneasy expression.

"That’s true, but wouldn’t it be a good idea to check anyway?"

"The 'fight for the throne' will soon begin."

Battle for the throne.

The main event of the fourth scenario, fighting for the only absolute throne on the Korean Peninsula.

**<Qualifications for King>**

1. 「The owner of the throne should be braver than anyone else.」

—The throne never wants a weak king. To challenge for the throne, you must be a king who possesses at least a [Black Flag].

2. 「He who dreams of the throne is also qualified for that desire.」

—There is a certain number of 'kings' who can challenge the absolute throne. To win the challenge, you must eliminate other kings around you.

The number of remaining kings was not yet indicated, but the number had been reduced in advance so there was nothing to worry about.

"Eliminate them all before the last condition opens. It would be better if you can also get the 'Death Sword'."

Just as they were preparing to rush in. A messenger shouted urgently.

"A group is approaching."

Along with the report, a group of incarnations were seen approaching from the opposite direction.

Chungmuro Group.

It was a group led by the Seventh Apostle Ye Hyunwoo and the military commander Gong Pildu.

One of the most powerful forces at the moment, possessing the 'black flag', but the king of their side seemed completely unconcerned.

"He looks confident."

"Of course. There is no problem with at least one of the seven apostles."

A powerful wave of magical energy pulsated from the tyrant king's entire body.

"Because I am not the 'tyrant king' of the original."

If you think about it, the Tyrant King in the original was a king who used the 'prophets' to gain power.

A powerful incarnation that uses the prophets as its background castle and uses the S-class item 'Three Rings' as his main weapon.

But now he had knowledge not of Ways of Survival, but of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

From the beginning, he acquired all kinds of hidden items and absorbed elixirs to increase his polymerization ability.

"Even if the third round's Yoo Joonghyuk is empty, I am confident that I can kill him."

It was possible for him now. Even if that 'Supreme King' appears, he won't be able to defeat him now.

As if representing his confidence, a tradition struck from the distant sky.

The tyrant king looked at the sky and dressed in triumph.

"It looks like <Star Stream> also knows who the strongest king is."

It sounded like an obvious villain's line. Maybe it was because he had read too many fantasy novels. The Tyrant King smiled bitterly. Once again, it was traditional. Lightning struck the ground intermittently. Even between the lightning strikes, something black was flying towards them.

What?

The Tyrant King frowned and held his weapon, and the shield soldiers guarding around him stepped forward.

The first to sense something strange was the Assassin King.

"That…"

When the Tyrant King turned around, the Assassin King, whose complexion had turned white, was already running away.

The moment the Tyrant King was about to shout something at the Assassin King, a black lightning bolt fell on their heads.

Jung Yonghu wielded a three-wheeled ring and released his magical power.

"This is it-"

There's just no way he could get hit by lightning. He was the Tyrant King Jung Yonghu.

"This is it-"

But something was strange. The moment he was struck by lightning, his three-wheeled ring was broken. It wasn't just the three-wheeled rings. Arms, legs. To be exact, everything in his body was falling apart.

"What is this-"

Leaving behind the final lines of a mass-produced villain, his soul was erased in a black lightning strike. Along with the fantasy novels he collected illegally.

As the thick dust settled, a landscape as if a meteorite had fallen unfolded.

The only thing that existed inside the deep crater was a man holding a pitch-black spear and looking vaguely at the sky.

The man swung it around as if testing his new acquisition and muttered.

"I felt like I felt energy from here. Was it an illusion?"

Then the little girl hanging on his back came down to the floor and asked.

"Brother. Who are you looking for?"

"There is such a guy."

The man carrying the girl on his shoulders again jumped lightly to the top of the crater.

Now, the incarnations nearby cried out in astonishment.

Ye Hyunwoo, who was at the head of the incarnations, muttered.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at Ye Hyunwoo.

Looking at those cool eyes, Ye Hyunwoo quickly raised both of his hands.

"I didn’t come here to fight."

Yoo Joonghyuk glanced at Ye Hyunwoo for a moment as if he was not interested, and then went to the collapsed building.

He looked towards the 'Palace Museum'.

"The scenario has changed again. Why did the museum collapse?"

"Who’s in there?"

Ye Hyunwoo, who was smiling, nodded his head.

"Is it Cheon Inho?"

Ye Hyunwoo didn’t know what to answer.

Now, there were quite a few powerful people inside the museum.

Moreover, if it was 'Cheon Inho', there was no need to worry much about whoever the opponent was.

That was until he saw Yoo Joonghyuk in front of him.

'It doesn't make sense.'

He was surprised when he saw it before, but not to this extent.

It was only 41 times.

It wasn't even 1,863 rounds, it was 41 rounds, which is the early part of the regressions.

But what on earth is this strength?

Ye Hyunwoo thought, salivating at his enthusiasm that made his neck feel like it would fly off just by getting close to him.

'If Yoo Joonghyuk is targeting other 'kings'…'

The second qualifications for the king had already been announced.

Yoo Joonghyuk will reduce the number of kings.

If he is moving to win, it could be dangerous to reveal Cheon Inho's whereabouts.

When Ye Hyunwoo didn't answer for a long time, Yoo Joonghyuk's eyebrows twitched.

The moment when the angle of the spear he was holding slowly changed.

[Hmm, I didn't know that the number of kings had already decreased so much.]

Tsutsutsu-

A dokkaebi appeared in the air making a sound.

[I guess it's time to start the final task.]

'Paul', a mid-level dokkaebi who appeared at the right time, announced the final task.

**<Qualifications for King>**

3. 「Therefore, the only king is the one who stands alone without anyone's help.」

—A king who can challenge the absolute throne must be able to prove his strength with only his body.

[Qualifications of the Last King begins.]

[Qualified kings move to the final battlefield's location.]

Finally, it was time to determine the owner of the throne.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 666 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (2)

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[You have hunted a 'Disaster' for the first time in the scenario.]

[You have achieved something no one else has achieved.]

[Payment of compensation related to the scenario is being delayed.]

[Payment of core rewards is determined based on contribution.]

[10,000 coins were obtained.]

Killer King, Cha Yerin, Lee Dansu, and the others looked blankly at the messages pouring out of the air.

[The reward for defeating 'Labyrinth Sentinel' has been obtained.]

[You have won 10,000 coins.]

[You have achieved a non-existent achievement!]

[Many constellations admire your achievements!]

[Someone recommended your story to the <Star Stream>]

In only the fourth scenario, they achieved the feat of defeating both level 5 and level 6 species.

Each person's contribution was different, but the reward was greater than any other scenario so far.

But no one in the group was happy about that.

"What is Cheon Inho’s condition?"

"Not good."

Yerin, who had taken a look at Cheon Inho, shook her head.

Killer King looked down at Cheon Inho, who was still unconscious, and saw the poisonous dragon species fall.

He recalled the last moments.

"If it weren’t for this guy, everyone would have died."

He could never have imagined that Cheon Inho would appear there. With a body that didn't even seem to have regained consciousness, Cheon Inho ran straight towards the dragon and ripped out its heart.

If it weren't for the woman who is taking care of Cheon Inho on the floor right now, Cheon Inho would have died.

Cheon Inho's face, poisoned by the poison of the poisonous dragon species, was the color of earth.

"Do you have any medicine?"

In order to neutralize Cheon Inho's poison, the party shook out all the elixirs they had. Although it was not a summoning level elixir, it was still a high quality medicine.

In addition, the core of the 'venomous dragon species' that just died.

The woman gathered her medicinal herbs, poured them into Cheon Inho's mouth, and cast a strange spell.

After a while, something like a small gold frame appeared on Cheon Inho's head, and his complexion began to improve.

Killer King asked.

"Do you know Cheon Inho?"

"Yes."

"Right."

The woman who suddenly appeared was not only the person who saved Cheon Inho, but said that she knew Cheon Inho.

Even though the situation was sufficiently strange to raise suspicion, Killer King did not bother to question it.

Because there were more urgent problems than that right now.

[The final king's qualifications will soon begin.]

Qualifications of the last king.

The main stage of 'Battle for the Throne' was finally upon them.

"We need the Death Sword."

'Death Sword' that can only be obtained by collecting seven star jewels.

Coincidentally, all seven jewels were gathered here now.

The problem is that, unlike the original story, the person who collects seven jewels is swept away by [madness] and becomes a monster.

Cha Yerin said as if holding back.

"It’s still dangerous. "I don’t know what will happen if he absorbs all seven star gems."

"I guess so."

Killer King looked down at the fallen Cheon Inho for a moment.

Cheon Inho risked his life to save them. But will he use Cheon Inho as a sacrifice to obtain the 'Death Sword'?

"Yoo Joonghyuk doesn’t do such cowardly things."

Lee Dansu sighed in relief, and Cha Yerin, who looked nervous, also stepped away.

But the crisis started now.

[The Last King's Qualifications begins.]

Killer King's expression hardened at the message coming from the air.

"It has begun."

The stage for 'Last Qualifications' had already opened.

Killer King looked back at Lee Dansu and said.

"I'm leaving without the Death Sword. All we have to do is somehow block Yoo Joonghyuk."

Behind the destruction of the 41st round of the original story was the 'absolute throne'.

"It would be the best if we could destroy the throne with the Death Sword, but even if it's not the best, there's no need to despair."

Even if they don't have the Death Sword, all they have to do is prevent anyone from taking the 'absolute throne'.

"We just have to hold out until the scenario changes. It prevents anyone from sitting on the throne."

Is the <Star Stream> looking for fun? There is a tendency to move towards more 'plausible' stories.

So as long as they make the scenario interesting, they will have a chance.

"Brother, the coins are…"

"I've collected enough."

"Take mine too."

To defeat Yoo Joonghyuk in 'The Last Qualification', you must use the method that Kim Dokja used.

And that method required a huge amount of coins.

Lee Dansu, who was watching the scene, asked.

"Isn’t Yerin the king?"

"Yes."

"Then..."

Killer King, who received Cha Yerin's gaze, responded.

"I am the king."

"Is that so."

"Immortal King. Are you curious about what kind of king I am?"

"Yes?"

Lee Dansu asked back blankly. He didn't know what to say, so he just muttered, but Killer King answered as he pleased.

"I am the 'Lonely King'."

"Lonely..."

Lee Dansu wondered if he had heard wrong. Come to think of it, when he was choosing the 'King Options', he remembered seeing an option with that name.

But he didn't know that there would be someone who would bother to choose a name like that.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' shakes his head.]

Even Cha Yerin secretly turned her head.

Killer King continued speaking with a shameless expression, as if he did not really understand such a reaction.

"If you include you, me, and Ye Hyunwoo outside, there are a total of three 'kings' who can attend the final stage. It would have been better if Cheon Inho was also here."

Cheon Inho, who fell to the floor, showed no signs of regaining consciousness.

In fact, just being alive was a miracle.

"For now, we have no choice but to try it on our own."

[Qualified kings move to the final battlefield’s location.]

That's right. The summoning was beginning with a sound.

Sparks flew through the bodies of Killer King and Lee Dansu.

"Yerin, please take care of Cheon Inho."

"Don't worry."

Killer King looked back at the woman one last time. The woman was still reciting her spell with her hand placed on Cheon Inho's forehead. That spell seemed to be suppressing Cheon Inho’s [Madness].

Killer King spoke to that woman.

"7942."

Then the woman slowly opened her eyes and answered.

"9158."

"You remember it well."

"Of course. This is the password I created."

Killer King nodded his head.

"First Apostle, are you going to participate in the war?"

Then the first apostle shook her head.

Killer King looked at the first apostle as if he was surprised, then turned his back and said.

"When Cheon Inho wakes up, tell him. I will protect this world."

---

In my hazy consciousness, I had a dream.

「"Author, but…"」

I realized it the moment I heard the voice.

I see.

This is Ji Eunyu’s dream.

「"Yes."」

The me in the dream answered.

I was afraid of what Ji Eunyu would say, and I was also looking forward to it.

「"In the last scene, Kim Dokja came back."」

Last scene.

I immediately realized what Ji Eunyu was talking about.

The moment the door to the hospital room opens and Han Sooyoung and Yoo Joonghyuk return. At the moment when the readers who had become 'the oldest dream' were wishing for Kim Dokja's resurrection, Ji Eunyu was talking about that last scene.

I cautiously opened my mouth, looking around in case anyone heard me.

「"He’s back. You don't know that, it's an open ending."」

Then Ji Eunyu frowned.

「"Do you really think so?"」

「"It has to be an open ending to increase the level of completion-"」

「"I don’t think the author has anything to say about the degree of completion."」

I thought for a moment and then hesitated.

「"To leave a deep impression on readers, like a spinning top that seems to never stop..."」

「"Would you like to get your head stuck with a top?"」

I frowned as I watched Ji Eunyu’s fist spinning like a top.

「"I don't know. Han Sooyoung wrote it. Ask Han Sooyoung."」

Ji Eunyu sighed lightly while looking at me and said.

「"Great. Let me ask you this. What if the author is the reader? What do you think when you see the last scene? Has Kim Dokja returned?"」

If I were a reader.

Actually, there is no need to ask that.

Because all the sentences in the last chapter refer to a single sentence that is not written down.

A puzzle with only one empty piece.

A unique non-existent sentence stands out more than any other sentence that exists.

「"Maybe he didn’t come back?"」

「"You will say that right away."」

「"Don’t go somewhere else and say I did that."」

「"Why did I do that? Rather, in what form did Kim Dokja return?"」

What shape is it?

「"That’s the ending. There are countless Kim Dokjas scattered throughout the universe, and isn’t it because their wishes came true that Kim Dokja came back to life?"」

Hearing it from someone else's mouth, it somehow feels like the ending of a children's fairy tale.

「"I guess so?"」

「"Then there must have been Kim Dokjas who each had their own thoughts. What would happen if those readers thought at the same time, 'Dokja Kim is back'?"」

「"Uh..."」

I hadn't thought of that.

I felt scared for a moment and asked.

「"Maybe I should write it again?"」

The moment I blinked and thought, "Please, I can’t do that," the scenery around me changed.

A ceiling blocked by a familiar stone wall.

The dimly shining light.

With the feeling of the floor, all the memories slowly came back.

Memories of entering the labyrinth to find the 'Death Sword'.

There, Killer King and others met Dansu ahjussi, absorbed the Star Jewels, a disaster was summoned, and the Labyrinth Watcher died...

I almost died too.

As my thoughts reached that point, someone suddenly came to mind.

Ji Eunyu.

[Currently you have acquired a total of 6 Star Jewels.]

[The power of the 'Star Jewel' erodes your body.]

[The 6th level of madness is encroaching on you.]

[An unknown force is suppressing your 'madness'.]

[An unknown force is interfering with the erosion of the 'Star Jewels'.]

I slowly got up. I felt a throbbing pain as if someone was squeezing my head.

There was no one around.

What happened?

Clearly, the disaster and the watchman have fallen.

Where have the other party members gone?

What happened to the scenario?

[The owner of 'Absolute Throne' has been chosen.]

At the momentary system message, I blinked blankly.

I thought I heard wrong.

'The owner of the absolute throne has been identified?'

The information in my head was sorted in an instant.

The owner of the throne has been decided. That means the 'fight for the throne' has already begun and is over.

「The fourth scenario has ended.」

I looked at the small star gem rolling around on the floor.

I have six star gems. And there's one rolling around over there.

「There is no Death Sword in this round.」

My fingertips were shaking. Something that shouldn't have happened happened.

I felt the dungeon vibrating.

I felt sick. I knew it instinctively. Something sinister is about to be born in this world.

[The owner of the 'absolute throne' is...]

A light came on in the distance and I heard someone running towards me.

[It is 'Incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

The destruction of the 41st round was decided.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 667 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (3)

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I immediately activated [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint].

I'm sure there are people thinking of me right now.

If just one person thought of me, they would know what's going on.

[The skill cannot currently be used.]

My head was pounding.

Is it that no one is thinking of me, or is it the aftereffects of using my skills for too long?

A light swaying in the distance illuminated this direction.

"Author?"

A woman was standing in the dark. She is a woman wearing a royal hanbok with rich brimstone colors and a crown on her head.

Such a person called me Author. Suddenly my head couldn't turn properly.

"Who are you?"

She looked at me as if she were disappointed and asked in a voice like her glass beads rolling.

"You don’t know who I am?"

Actually, I understood it in My head. Of course, there is only one person in this world who can call me 'author'.

Still, verification was necessary.

"When was the first serial published from Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint?"

"January 2nd, the second year since I joined the company."

"What does 1,863 mean?"

"You use it without even thinking about that."

"How many rounds will this world line be in?"

"The 41st rounds."

I felt like crying a little.

It is certain. It's definitely true.

This person in front of me is my one and only editor.

"Editor."

"Author."

We held each other's hands for a moment with tears in our eyes.

---

When the serialization of ORV was just beginning, I once received such a question from a reader.

—If you were to possess a character, what character would you want to possess?

Now that I think about it, I don't know if that comment was written by Representative Kim Dokja.

—Well, there are people I want to possess... If I were to be honest, there are people I don't want to possess. For example...

At that time, I wrote a reply but did not click the OK button.

I didn't want to disturb the readers' appreciation by adding the author's personal opinion.

So, 'Shall we think about it until it’s finished?' I just answered.

Ji Eunyu, who read the comment at that time, said this.

—First of all, I will not possess Kim Dokja.

—Because you keep dying?

—Yes.

—Then what...

— Jung Heewon or Lee Hyunsung...

—They almost died too. Doesn’t Lee Hyunsung die once too?

That's right.

If you think about it, among the characters in ORV, there is only one person who remains sane until the end.

—The best character is one who survives until the end as quietly as possible, as if they were not there.

It was indeed a remark befitting a veteran web novel editor.

Maybe the reason Ji Eunyu is now possessed by that person is because of that comment at that time.

So, is Ji Eunyu satisfied now?

"Anyway, Min Jiwon is a bit..."

I don't think so.

The person that Ji Eunyu possessed was: Min Jiwon, the King of Beauty.

In the original work, the incarnation of Silla's King. In terms of appearance, she is one of the best in the entire 'Ways of Survival', and even briefly shows interest in Kim Dokja.

"I think she’s the person the editor wanted to possess so that you survive as quietly as possible, as if you don’t exist."

"No. Who would have said that, knowing that I would actually possess someone? This isn’t the author’s doing, is it?"

I protested to Ji Eunyu, who glared at me with a coy look.

"If I had taken the lead in this situation, would I have bothered to possess Cheon Inho?"

"But."

Ji Eunyu nodded meaningfully and added.

“But does Cheon Inho look like that? It looks like he’s had some cosmetic modifications done."

"I didn’t specifically say that Cheon Inho was ugly."

As we stared at each other for a moment, I suddenly remembered what kind of person Ji Eunyu was.

She was someone who would debate with me for 30 minutes over a single sentence. She was a person who did not tolerate sentences that did not fit the context or rhythm.

She supported my story more than anyone else, but did not go away when the plot was uneasy or the balance of the story was shaken.

"Anyway, I’m glad you’re alive, author."

The person who always says what I have to say first.

"Editor."

"There are a lot of things I want to ask, but I don’t think now is the time to clear things up among ourselves, right?"

I nodded.

But I couldn't figure out what to do first.

Fortunately, Ji Eunyu is the person who knows best what to do in times like this.

[Incarnation: Min Jiwon activates Cannery Factory Lv.3.]

The surrounding scenery swayed as if it had been filtered, and soon changed into a familiar space.

"Here-"

"It's been a while?"

I never thought I would see this scenery again.

A reading room desk packed in a space of about 8 pyeong. There is one computer on each desk. Coffee mix and biscuit bags piled on the table in the center.

This was the 'writing room' of Ji Eunyu's company.

"Maybe it's because I'm an editor, so I have this skill."

Also known as 'cannery factory'.

A place to capture writers whose serialization cycle is erratic or who have abandoned the deadline and run away.

I, too, have been caught here several times to write when I was planning a new work.

"Time passes slowly in this space. One second in real life is about 10 minutes here."

It was a ridiculous time multiplier.

"Instead, the skill cooldown is long and the duration is short. Currently, it is only about 10 minutes. In real time, it would be about 1 second."

10 minutes.

It was a short time, but it was the time I really needed right now.

I thanked Ji Eunyu for her consideration and organized the situation in my head before opening my mouth.

"Then can I ask you a few questions?"

"Yes."

"What happened to the people who were with me?"

Obviously, right before I met Ji Eunyu, I was with the Killer King's group. But now these companions are nowhere to be seen.

"The apostle."

As expected, Ji Eunyu also knew about 'Apostles'.

"He went to participate in the 'Last King's Qualification'. He appeased them by telling them that he would prevent the destruction of the world."

I didn't have to ask who said that.

I looked again at the message log I received earlier.

[The owner of the final absolute throne is incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk.]

Even though the apostles participated in the 'struggle for the throne', that message came to mind.

Then the situation was clear.

[Killer King and the apostles were defeated.]

None of them could stop Yoo Joonghyuk. Suddenly, my mind seemed to turn white.

「What happened to the apostles? Killer King, Cha Yerin, Dansu ahjussi, Ye Hyunwoo...」

「What if Yoo Joonghyuk killed them?」

「What will happen next?」

「The Absolute Throne is an item connected to the Other World. Now Seoul is-!」

"Author, you don't like the current development."

"Yes?"

Even in this situation, Ji Eunyu still spoke like a pen holder. Is that why? I also started thinking like a writer.

"I don’t like it, Yoo Joonghyuk has the 'Absolute Throne'."

"Then why not?"

"If he uses his legacy to secure the 'absolute throne', this world will fall into ruin. You know that."

"But that’s the original story."

I was silent for a moment.

She was right.

This was the development of the 41st round of the 'predetermined' Ways of Survival.

Yoo Joonghyuk takes the absolute throne and the world heads toward destruction.

Shin Yoosung becomes a wanderer in the world line.

"Are you doing this because you feel sorry for the characters? Are you trying to save them by changing the plot?"

"…"

"Is that really the right choice? Maybe this is just the right thing to do. In the 41st round, Yoo Joonghyuk perishes as planned, Shin Yoosung goes to the past, and that’s how the Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint we know begins."

"…"

"The author knows very well the kind of catastrophe that a story altered by excessive greed can lead to."

At least Ji Eunyu was always right about the manuscript.

In some stories, if you change one thing, the whole story collapses. Trying to protect one world line. The entire world line of the universe may collapse.

But this time, I had a reason.

If this were a simple novel, I would have accepted Ji Eunyu’s words. But this world was not just a 'novel'.

"There are readers who are possessed in this world."

"I know. So do I."

Even though her life was at stake, Ji Eunyu responded calmly.

"But this isn't something the author started. Did the author make the readers possess characters here?"

"No."

"Then it's not the author's responsibility."

Was Ji Eunyu such a cold-hearted person?

"I guess I can say it this way. Now that it's clear that this world is not 'yours', the tragedies that occur in this world are not the author's responsibility."

Responsibility.

"The author always joked that this was written by Han Sooyoung, which means it's not our job to put us back in our original positions or end the story."

Ji Eunyu was speaking.

The responsibility for the story lies with the person who started the story.

So who started this story?

Is this Han Sooyoung? Is it Representative Kim Dokja?

I stared blankly at the computers in the writing room. No one was sitting in front of the computer.

Without realizing it, I reached for the chair and Ji Eunyu added something.

"If you change the plot, this really becomes the author's story."

My story.

"If someone dies or gets injured due to the changed plot, it will all be the author's responsibility. Can you handle it? You had a hard time even reading a single bad comment. This is a different matter than that."

"But the possessed readers…"

"Whether they are possessing characters in a novel or not, humans will die someday."

Ji Eunyu said as she pushed the chair back.

"I think it's a bit unlucky, but since I've already possessed someone, I just have to live as I possessed them. You never know. It might be a happier life to somehow survive here for a long time rather than living as 'editor Ji Eunyu'."

I looked at Ji Eunyu.

"There is no guarantee that the story the author changes will be better."

Ji Eunyu was speaking.

Don't start this story.

I was reminded of the countless stories I worked with her on that I could tell the ending of a story before it even started.

Numerous works that started excitingly but were never completed.

"This time, we can’t just do it all year round and run away because it’s not popular."

Nevertheless, I keep being drawn to such stories.

Even though it is painful to read the story I wrote, I still write the next sentence.

I spend my time writing stories about the lives and deaths of beings other than myself.

"Don’t write this story?"

"Yes."

"Then why do you still call me Author?"

Ji Eunyu’s eyes looked at me.

I continued to say.

"I already wrote the story."

At Geumho Station, Chungmuro, and Seoul Station, I wrote stories.

"Someone has already died and someone has survived because of me."

There is no excuse for that fact.

"So I have to write it to the end somehow. Even if it’s not interesting or popular, even if only one person reads it. So please help me, editor."

Ji Eunyu looked at me like that.

It was a look I knew well.

Every time I put out a new work without a solution. Ji Eunyu always reviewed the manuscript with the same gaze.

Is the material novel, is the plot detailed, and does it fit the trend? After completing such a short review, Ji Eunyu would always ask me in the same tone.

"Do you really want to do it?"

"Yes."

I don't want to destroy this world.

I want to save people.

I will return readers to their original world.

I want to give this poorly written story a full ending.

Ji Eunyu sighed lightly and said.

"The owner of the throne has been identified, but it may not be too late."

It's not too late.

"King of a kingless world… Don’t you remember when you wrote the round?"

A pile of short memories flowed through my mind.

“Until Kim Dokja sat on the throne, the 'Absolute Throne' was not activated."

Ji Eunyu’s words naturally brought up a scene in my mind.

Kim Dokja, who proved his 'final qualifications' and became the 'only king of Seoul'.

However, because Kim Dokja refused to sit on the throne, the 'absolute throne' was not activated.

That is to say,

"If only you could prevent Yoo Joonghyuk from sitting on the throne."

If only we could stop the 'coronation ceremony'.

[If only we could cut off the constellation of the 'Absolute Throne' before he sits on the throne.]

There were two things to do for it.

First, get out of this dungeon.

And the second is,

[Obtaining the 'Death Sword' that will destroy the throne...]

[Exclusive skill, 'Cannery Factory' is unlocked.]

I looked down at the 'last star gem' rolling around on the floor of the star labyrinth.

There are a total of six 'star jewels' I currently have.

「If I collect seven star gems, I can summon the Death Sword.」

However, in order to be summoned, I must endure '7 levels of madness'.

[Stage 6 of madness is eroding you.]

[An unknown force is suppressing your 'madness'.]

I looked at Ji Eunyu.

The heat that gripped my head, the pain, and the strange feeling of dizziness felt throughout Ji Eunyu's whole body. The things that Ji Eunyu didn't say and the things that I didn't ask about formed a series in my head.

Ji Eunyu said as I picked up the star gem that had fallen on the floor.

"If you write it, please show it to me."

I nodded.

I don't know if the story we changed will be successful.

[Incarnation Cheon Inho has acquired all seven star gems!]

However, I am writing a story, and…

[Stage 7 of Madness is eroding you!]

She will fix this story.

Along with Ji Eunyu's spell, something strongly clamped down on my head.

[The supernormal ability of 'Gingoa' controls your 'madness'.]

I stretched out my hand toward the emblem shining brightly in the air.

A sword hilt that fits gently in the palm of your hand. The sentence I had rewritten several times was finally becoming reality.

[Incarnation 'Cheon Inho' has summoned the 'Death Sword'!]

Now, it is time to go face the King of Seoul.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 668 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (4)

We left the dungeon right away. Once we acquired the Death Sword, there was no longer any reason to stay in the 'Star Labyrinth'.

[Escape from the 'Star Labyrinth'.]

As we came out of the labyrinth, a collapsed waiting room appeared. Has the nearby terrain changed because of everything outside?

Even if I didn't have to use the 'Everchanging Stealth Suit', it seemed like a way out could be opened by clearing away a few piles of rocks. Since I didn't have much time, I started working right away. And as if passing by, I opened my mouth.

"But editor."

"Yes."

"That one from earlier is 'Gingoa'."

Ji Eunyu answered, digging in the field with me.

"It’s the power of my constellation."

Ji Eunyu suppressed my [madness] by borrowing the spell of 'Gingoa'. If it weren't for her, the summoning of the 'Death Sword' would have been impossible to even attempt. However, a constellation of that level did not have the virtue to cause such a miracle.

[The constellation 'God of Alcohol and Ectasy' looks at Min Jiwon.]

[The constellation 'Liar With a Long Nose' asks, isn't that the constellation Gingoa?]

[The constellation 'Reclining Dragon' is handling its ink.]

[Some constellations are astonished by 'Gingoa's' supernatural abilities!]

[Some Holy Sees request a probability check from the Administration!]

Gingoa's holy relic.

[The constellation 'The Prisoner of the Golden Headband picks his ears.]

To be exact, it was from the 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband– a relic of the Great Sage, Heaven's Equal.

So, is Ji Eunyu's background character Jecheon Daeseong? Or is it Shakyamuni or Buddhist Master Sanjang who gave the Great Sage, Heaven's Equal that relic?

If not that too.

"There is a price, right?"

Ji Eunyu's pupils briefly wavered at my question.

I expected it.

It was not a power that could be exercised in only the fourth scenario. It was a transfer that was enough to neutralize one of the core conditions of the initial scenario. Even if her constellation was the Great Sage, Heaven's Equal, it would not be easy.

One step later, Ji Eunyu's head moved.

"I cannot participate in this scenario as a 'king'."

I knew it. Perhaps her constellation negotiated with the administration on the condition that their own incarnation did not obtain the 'King's Tale'.

After digging through the last remains of the museum, we saw Gwanghwamun in the distance. Dark red clouds were swirling above the pitch-black sky.

It was a precursor to the 'Great Hall'.

"Go quickly."

I nodded.

Maybe it's already too late.

Yoo Joonghyuk has already sat on the absolute throne, and this world's destruction may have been confirmed.

Even so, I have to see it with my own eyes. At least, I have an obligation to do so now.

"I'll be back."

After catching a glimpse of Ji Eunyu for a moment, I ran straight toward the square.

---

Ji Eunyu saw the back of Lee Hakhyun walking away.

She wanted to let him know he could stop it.

This isn't a novel, it's real life. If he dies there, he'll really die.

But just as she couldn't stop Lee Hakhyun's novels from failing, she couldn't stop Lee Hakhyun this time either.

Ji Eunyu thought of the face of Lee Hakhyun she knew. For some reason, his face could not come to mind clearly, but she clearly remembered what kind of person he was.

'Love for stories.'

There are many people who like stories.

But in her opinion, Lee Hakhyun was especially special. He's been like that since they first met. He was always writing sentences, wherever he was.

It was as if he was afraid of all the 'space' that exists in this world.

Blood flowed from inside. As she lightly bent down and spat out blood, a message rang in her head.

[You have used power that has surpassed its limits.]

As expected, it was unreasonable to use 'Gingoa' for the beginning scenarios.

If it weren't for her constellation in the first place, she wouldn't have been able to even try.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' looks worried.]

Ji Eunyu could feel the gaze of the constellation behind her watching her from the sky.

Lotus flower blooming under the moonlight.

Her constellation was a well-known leading role in 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint'.

The person who protected Kim Dokja in the closest place to Kim Dokja.

In a sense, she is a being who understands human beings better than anyone else.

"Yoo Sangah."

Light sparks flew in the air, and her reply was answered.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' says it is not too late.]

It's not too late.

She knew that Lee Hakhyun's 'It's not too late' and her constellation’s 'It's not too late' had completely different meanings.

"Do you think the author is wrong? Do you still think this story shouldn’t be changed?"

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' says that it does not matter whether it is right or wrong.]

It doesn't matter whether it's right or wrong

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' says that all stories just flow towards an ending.]

"If you become a constellation, will everyone talk like a constellation?"

She did not say anything.

Ji Eunyu added, looking up into space with a bitter expression.

"The author probably knows, too, that my constellation is you."

Lee Hakhyun is not an idiot.

Probably, the moment Lee Hakhyun witnessed the power of 'Gingoa', he would have already realized everything.

Throughout 'Omniscient Reader's , there are only a handful of beings who can cause such a miracle.

"What do you want?"

[The constellation 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight' answers the 'end'.]

"You just want to get 'your Kim Dokja' back."

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' is silent.]

"What will happen to this world if the ending you wish for comes true? Will it be destroyed as planned?"

[The constellation 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight' hesitates to answer.]

Ji Eunyu did not dig further. Perhaps this is an unanswerable question for her constellation.

And maybe that wasn't really what she was curious about.

"Are me and the author... one of those 'fragments'?"

Before she knew it, the back of Lee Hakhyun's head was far away.

She could see his white coat shaking from the rain.

Ji Eunyu thought that the coat looked good on him. Still, she also wished he didn't wear that coat.

Her constellation did not reply for a long time.

A note was heard from far away. It seemed like the fight had started again.

When Lee Hakhyun finally disappeared, her constellation opened her mouth.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' says that the ending of this story is fixed, but no one knows the ending of “this” story.]

Those were strange words. Those strange words were somehow familiar to Ji Eunyu.

She said, "That sounds exactly like the first sentence of a novel I know."

Probably because she already knows similar sentences.

She said, "There are ways to survive in a ruined world, and now I've forgotten some of them."

After hesitating for a moment, Ji Eunyu added her words again. She edited a story for a long time, sentences she read and reread.

"But one thing is certain. That is, if you are reading this right now, you will stay alive."

Ji Eunyu prayed that the sentence was true.

---

Rain fell from the sky over Gwanghwamun. The rain mixed with blood and dyed the floor red. A man's face was reflected in the pool of blood.

Looking at that unfamiliar face, Killer King swallowed a sigh.

'How can this happen?'

Everything was calculated.

'The Last King' proceeded as he expected, and so did the content of the scenario.

> 3. 「Therefore, the only king is the one who stands alone without anyone’s help.
>
> —A king who can challenge the absolute throne must be able to prove his strength with only his body.

[From now on, no king will be able to receive support from their constellation.]

[From now on, the attack and defense power of all items will be limited.]

[From now on, all skills, stigma, and special options for items will be sealed.]

[From now on, all kings' overall stats will change to 10/10/10/10/10.]

[The 'Qualification of the Last King' continues until the last person remains.]

The 'last king's qualification' was a 'raw battle' in which no equipment, skills, or stigma could be used.

An ordeal in which everyone has the same level 10 overall abilities and must defeat all other kings with just one body.

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' sighs and monitors the situation.]

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' congratulates the new owner of the throne.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks if that makes sense now.]

[Many constellations are astonished by the results of 'The Last Qualifications'.]

Killer King has been steadily preparing for this ordeal ever since he possessed a character.

The key point of 'Qualifications for the Last King' is to collect as many 'coins' as possible. In the main story, Kim Dokja used coins in this battlefield to temporarily increase his overall abilities to the limit, and used a trick to defeat Yoo Joonghyuk.

[83,000 coins were consumed.]

So Killer King did the same. He collected more coins than Kim Dokja in the main story, and poured out more coins generously. It was capital that would disappear when the scenario ended, but he didn't care. This is because it was more important to stop Yoo Joonghyuk in front of him.

In fact, the operation worked. He strengthened his overall abilities to the limit and gave Yoo Joonghyuk a hard time with his strength exceeding 100.

Until then, the operation was effective. He thought it was valid.

"It looks like you used all your coins."

That was until Yoo Joonghyuk stopped him.

"Where did you get this information?"

Is it simply because his abilities were high?

It wasn't. His abilities were his abilities, but the Yoo Joonghyuk in front of him had a different cost.

Softness that controls strength. There was an unprecedented energy spreading from Yoo Joonghyuk's palm. It was neither a skill nor a power. Nevertheless, the power that is the 'source of all power'.

He felt goosebumps running down his spine.

'There were no restrictions not to use stories.'

But this realization came too late. His vision became dark and he fell to the ground.

He couldn't understand what was happening.

When he opened his eyes with a feeling of nausea, he saw the Immortal King Lee Dansu and Bald-headed King Gong Pildu lying on the floor.

The Assassin King was also seen absconding immediately and hiding among the crowd.

A late sigh came out.

[Incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has passed all the tests of 'Absolute Throne'.]

Finished.

Killer King lifted his head in a daze and watched the back of Yoo Joonghyuk moving away.

They lost.

As Yoo Joonghyuk took one step, the crowd retreated like waves. Even those who were overwhelmed by his spirit bowed to their knees.

There was.

"Supreme King…"

Someone called him by a nickname.

"Supreme King! The winner is the Supreme King!"

"The only king of the Korean peninsula!"

The commotion then turned into cheers. Some were afraid of him, some were jealous of him.

And everyone was in awe of him.

An overwhelming force that single-handedly defeated all kings.

Looking at Yoo Joonghyuk like that, Killer King thought.

「I am not Yoo Joonghyuk.」

He stumbled and got up from the floor.

He knew he couldn't fight. He was really feeling this. Even if all the possessed readers gather together, it will be impossible to stop Yoo Joonghyuk.

Nevertheless, Killer King promised.

'I am Ja Sungwoo.'

I will stop the world's destruction.

There was no hesitation in Yoo Joonghyuk’s steps. There were now less than thirty steps left to the 'Absolute Throne'.

"Brother!"

When did she escape from the dungeon?

Yerin, who had recovered from her internal injuries to some extent, was running towards him, releasing her magical energy from all over her body.

[Incarnation 'Lee Seyeon'’s 'Battle Action Mode' is activated!]

Battle action mode.

Killer King looked at the controller that appeared in front of him.

There is no other way.

They have to stop Yoo Joonghyuk somehow. And this skill was the strongest skill that the siblings could use together.

A special move that can inflict fatal wounds on even an S-class poisonous dragon.

With this, it was theoretically possible to deal with Yoo Joonghyuk.

But why does he have this ominous feeling?

"Is it a game?"

The moment Killer King heard Yoo Joonghyuk's muttering, he felt like he had been doused with cold water. Why did he forget it?

"Yerin!"

He grabbed the controller and ran.

This fight can never be won.

The opponent is none other than the 'Supreme King'.

And the Supreme King's previous occupation was—

[Incarnation's 'Yoo Joonghyuk'’s characteristic is activated!]

Kwaaaaaaaa!

With a loud noise, Cha Yerin's body crumpled after activating the skill.

Killer King barely caught her sister as she flew away, coughing up blood.

His younger sister was screaming and coughing up blood.

He could see traces of the [Hundred Steps Divine Fist] that had passed through her waist.

A blow that accurately predicted the preparatory movements just before death. In that short period of time, Yoo Joonghyuk realized the weakness of [Battle Action Mode].

"Do you want to die?"

Killer King slowly looked around.

No one has died yet.

That fact reassured him and despaired him at the same time.

The Supreme King had been looking after them until now.

They can't win.

His body was giving in before his mind.

He thought he knew Yoo Joonghyuk well until now. He read the entire novel 100 times and believed that he understood him more accurately than the author who wrote the story.

But this is something else.

The moment he met Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes, Killer King became distant, like a person facing a book whose thickness he could not guess.

The life he lived is so different.

No one can stop him.

No one can understand him.

No one in this world-

"Until there."

A small grumbling voice.

"Damn it. I never wanted to go through this scenario again."

Someone blocked Yoo Joonghyuk's path.

A blue combat uniform made of elastic material.

The 'Blade of Faith' spits out brilliant white light from its blade.

"Aren’t you tired too?"

The person standing there was not Kim Dokja. But in a sense, she was a person who understood this world better than Kim Dokja.

Everyone in the place, including Killer King, Cha Yerin, and Lee Dansu, looked at the same face in fascination.

It was their first time seeing this face.

But it was a face that they all could not help but recognize.

The person who summoned the 'Death Sword' before anyone else in the original story. The one who went beyond the king and called herself the Black Flames Empress.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

A writer in this world.

"Can you stop writing your story now?"

Han Sooyoung.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 669 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (5)

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The 'Absolute Throne' was shining in the distance.

A seat where only one king can sit.

At one time, Han Sooyoung also wanted to sit in that seat. She believed that if she sat down there, she would be compensated for all the sorrow she had endured.

That was until she realized that even that desire was nothing more than a play for the constellations.

[A significant number of constellations are aware of your presence.]

[Very few constellations are concerned about your intervention.]

[Some constellations are requesting the Bureau to review your probability.]

She could feel the gaze of the stars across the distant sky.

Will the stars understand her story now?

[A constellation that has not yet revealed its modifier is looking at you.]

What she wanted was farther and farther away than that throne.

It was so distant that she couldn't quite tell what it was.

「She had no reason to intervene in this situation.」

This was the 41st round's normal development.

Yoo Joonghyuk, in the 41st round, will take the 'absolute throne' and walk the path of a supreme king who rules over everything.

No one will be able to stand on the same level as him.

No path will arise for him.

「Just leave it alone.」

If she just sat back and watched, the 41st round would end up in failure.

At the end of this story, Yoo Joonghyuk, in despair, will send Shin Yoosung to the past.

That ends the story of this world line.

Kim Dokja will return to her again after reading all of her stories.

He has to come back.

For his sake, she must not move. Not write even a single sentence.

She has to let the characters move and flow. She knew it well. But why?

"Yoo Joonghyuk. If you sit over there, it's all over."

Did she finally pick up the pen?

"You guessed it too, right? What the absolute throne is."

Of course, she knows the answer.

Even now, when she closes her eyes, the memory comes to mind clearly. It may be because she saw something she shouldn't have seen.

「"What you're trying to do is not end the story, but give up."」

Kim Dokja, whom she ignored. Kim Dokja, who did not want to be reborn as Kim Dokja again.

Nevertheless, Kim Dokja had to return to this story again.

She found Kim Dokja and that's why she's here now.

"Are you Han Sooyoung?"

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round was looking at her.

Han Sooyoung asked bitterly.

"Who told you my name?"

Han Sooyoung quietly stared at the Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st round.

"I owed you a beating last time."

This was her second fight with Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round.

"Do you think this time will be different?"

"It will be different."

"It looks like your learning ability is poor. If you've ever fought, you'd know that, right? It's not for me."

On the rooftop of the theater dungeon, she bumped into Yoo Joonghyuk once.

She risked the odds and drew on her story, and she took advantage of the weakness of 'regressive depression' to subdue Yoo Joonghyuk.

But is that possible this time too?

She couldn't figure it out.

"Well, you must have regressed more than 40 times."

She didn't know, so she deliberately provoked him. She tried to spy on the guy's reaction, but Yoo Joonghyuk didn't come over. His eyes, deep as the sea of silk, just stared at her.

All surrounding sounds disappeared.

Tension weighing heavily on the area. Silence where not a single insect cries.

The one who moved first was Han Sooyoung.

The sound of something being pushed away was heard one step later, and his black spear and her white sword clashed in the air.

Her magical power and his physical power intertwined, and a tearing sound rose through the rain clouds.

She lost.

Kaaaaang!

A lightning-like dramatic impact weighed heavily on Han Sooyoung. Let's believe in her spirit and her skills. Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth.

"It seems you also know about regression."

"So are you surprised?"

"I expected it."

Yoo Joonghyuk spoke without even raising an eyebrow.

"Because there were a lot of strange people in this round."

Strange guys. Han Sooyoung knew who he was referring to.

"Everyone said they knew me."

Her sharp emotions were buried at the end of her words. The anger of the returner who had been forged again and again was condensing.

[Incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk''s 'Spiritual Soul Height Lv.10' is activated!]

Black magical power swirled in the gravitational force of the spear.

Han Sooyoung's expression hardened at the creepy waveform of magical power.

From now on, it's real.

Han Sooyoung took her chances and opened up her own stories.

With the sound of her striking the black flame dragon's holy soul drum, which made her called her special flame black dragon Emperor, the pole pole filled with her [Earth and Soul Field] and the dot pole filled with [special flame] collided.

She was Han Sooyoung and she was confident.

Even though Yoo Joonghyuk was a powerful martial artist, there was no way he could stand up to her.

Coo coo coo coo!

A magic wave that turns one side of the sky pitch black.

The first to be pushed out was Han Sooyoung. Han Sooyoung's expression was so disgusted that she cried and swallowed the blood that came up her throat.

'Nonsense.'

No matter how the aftereffects of probability were, she was the one who saw the end of the scenarios twice.

The Yoo Joonghyuk floating in the sky right now was only Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st round.

But how?

「"Don’t underestimate me in the 41st round."」

One step too late, the advice of her fellow regressor came to mind.

「"It’s only the 41st round, so what?"」

「"His character may be different."」

This world was not even recorded in Ways of Survival.

In a sense, it is a world line that writer Han Sooyoung does not really know.

Yoo Joonghyuk lived a 41-rounds life that no one recorded.

That Yoo Joonghyuk was speaking.

"Do you know me too?"

Han Sooyoung bit her lip.

「She said, "You are the one who sent Shin Yoosung to the past because you thought you couldn’t do it alone. How strong can a guy who gave up so easily be?"」

「"That’s the problem."」

「"What?"」

「"There is no way I could have collapsed that much in only the 41st round."」

Han Sooyoung looked at Yoo Joonghyuk. He was telling the story embedded in his whole body.

That story is proof of his life.

Han Sooyoung slowly felt a chill go down her spine.

「"In that world line, I have given up on the possibility of the next round. I probably saw a despair that I couldn't overcome no matter how hard I tried. I concluded that I, who can return on my own, cannot see the end without sending Shin Yoosung to another world line."」

Looking at Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes, Han Sooyoung thinks about the regressor.

the world, excluding the regressor, regresses.

The soul of the regressor continues to age and memories accumulate.

Touching and sick heart.

Endless depression and madness.

Han Sooyoung also knew.

Regression was not a curse that an ordinary human could bear, and Yoo Joonghyuk was not an ordinary human.

Steel-like mentality and unwavering spirit. Yoo Joonghyuk is a person who is so strong that he cannot be described simply as 'strong'.

A protagonist created to endure a number of 1,863 regressions.

「"If I made such an extreme judgment in only the 41st round."」

The 'main character' gave up his future in only the 41st round. And he tied the future to his past self.

「"That guy did his best to the point where he couldn’t survive his next life."」

"It seems you don’t know."

A story arose.

It's an endlessly cancerous and ominous story that they don't know when or how it was acquired.

Han Sooyoung thought.

Really strong. It's hard to believe that it's the 41st round. He seems stronger than any other 'Yoo Joonghyuk' who lived through the fourth scenario.

If she uses Kim Dokja Company's story, she can win. But if she does that…

[The <Star Stream> is reacting to your choices.]

This time, the probability of this world will not forgive her.

Ga-ga-ga-ga-gak!

Seeing Yoo Joonghyuk's sword flying, Han Sooyoung also swung her sword in front of her.

Once, twice, three times.

Every time her spear and sword clashed, the sound of her grip being torn apart could be heard.

Her blood flowed and her nerves became numb little by little.

Four times.

Han Sooyoung finally lost her sword.

'Unbreakable Faith' broke and fell to the ground.

A moment's gap.

Yoo Joonghyuk did not hesitate. As if there was no place for her in this world, Yoo Joonghyuk threw out his spear with a cold motion.

A slow blow to the heart.

Han Sooyoung looked down at her own wounds as if she couldn't believe it, and then looked up at Yoo Joonghyuk.

That was the last time.

It was a life-threatening wound that did not need to be repeated twice.

Yoo Joonghyuk retrieved his own spear the moment after seeing Han Sooyoung had disappeared.

"It hurts, kid."

A voice came from behind.

Yoo Joonghyuk, startled, immediately tried to swing the spear backwards.

"Do you know how much memory loss there is once your avatar dies?"

Two small, soft hands wrapped around his head.

Tsutsutsutsuchut!

A dazzling spark and a terrible shock engulfed Yoo Joonghyuk's mind. Unable to withstand the aftermath, Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body trembled like an aspen tree.

The story in Han Sooyoung's hands burrowed into Yoo Joonghyuk's head.

「"The stronger the guy, the heavier the weight of his despair."」

This is what her colleague told her.

「"Probably, he will easily sink to just one feather."」

Han Sooyoung knew better than anyone else what the weakness of a regressor who experienced deep despair was.

[The gaint story, 'Kim Dokja's Company' begins.]

His stomach churned and his whole body trembled as if he had been shocked.

"What do happy memories taste like, you bastard?"

Memories of <Kim Dokja Company> flowed from her fingertips.

「"Why is that kid so good at cooking?"」

Memories of Kim Dokja and her stealing Yoo Joonghyuk's dishes and eating them.

Memories of the picnic where <Kim Dokja's Company> gathered together and left. In their story that had not yet ended, Kim Dokja that she remembered was speaking.

「"Next time, let's bring more beef."」

Han Sooyoung looked at the story blankly. The fact that such a time even existed now seemed unrealistic.

A person who can exist only in sentences.

The stories that were clearly her memories now seemed like lies in a novel written by someone else.

Han Sooyoung smiled as she looked at Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes that had turned white.

"I'm about to die of happiness."

Happiness. As she pronounced that word, Han Sooyoung momentarily tilted her head.

What was that?

Is it because the avatar died and lost some of her memories? Han Sooyoung couldn't immediately remember the meaning of that word. Perhaps that wasn't all she had lost.

However, she trusted Han Sooyoung.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' is watching you.]

Her companion who would remember those words for her.

「"I told you I'd try to persuade you. Are you ready to be persuaded?"」

Find a writer to write her story for her.

"You damn son of a bitch."

Han Sooyoung finally understood her own actions, muttering a phrase that she would never use.

All writers were readers before they were writers, and Han Sooyoung was the same.

I'm curious about the story he makes. Even after all that hardship, he came back to this world, and the story he wanted to tell was.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' looks at you with sad eyes.]

So she stopped Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' bows his head.]

She acted arbitrarily without consulting with other members of <Kim Dokja's Company>.

"You think so too, Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Maybe because of her choice, she knew that all the plans she had made could go wrong.

Taking a light breath, Han Sooyoung lifted the stunned Yoo Joonghyuk onto her shoulder.

She didn't have much time left now.

Yoo Joonghyuk will wake up soon.

In the meantime, she must destroy the 'Absolute Throne'.

Only then will this scenario end.

「But there was something she didn't know.」

Han Sooyoung suddenly felt the hairs on the back of her hand stand up.

With a deafening sound, she heard the strange sound of a huge scale tipping from somewhere.

Han Sooyoung immediately realized what was happening. She has participated in this scenario on other floating ships, so it is unlikely that the abnormality she caused would lead to a riot, but she did not expect the fallout to take this form.

The probability was running wild.

Han Sooyoung opened her mouth without realizing it. She knew this feeling well.

"The 'Great Hall' opens."

A huge hole was opening beyond the black swirling sky.

[The gods of this world have noticed your presence!]

[The scales of probability are in equilibrium.]

The owner of the 'Absolute Throne' was appearing beyond the 'Great Hall of the Sky'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 670 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (6)

A shadow lingered across the swirling Great Hall.

[The constellation 'Bald Commander of justice' wipes his head in astonishment.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' opens its eyes to the god of the other world.]

[The constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' hides in a brick house.]

[The constellation 'Dog that Threw Itself into the Flames' gasps and retreats.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' frowns.]

[Multiple constellations are astonished by the intervention of the outer gods in the scenario!]

The constellations of the channel were agitated just by the flickering of a shadow.

[A few constellations prepare to leave the channel.]

There were even constellations preparing to flee.

It could have been so.

The outer god who has now revealed his presence in the sky is not a nameless one.

It was clearly 'named'.

[The constellation 'Jejeon Daeseong' stares at the founder of this absolute throne.]

The first owner of the absolute throne and the creator of the throne.

At one time, Kim Dokja swung the Death Sword against outer god and destroyed the absolute throne.

'Was that kind of guy that Kim Dokja was dealing with?'

Han Sooyoung also does not know specifically about the 'founder of the absolute throne'.

More exactly, she knew but she forgot.

Not long ago, when she met Lee Hakhyun,

she gave Lee Hakhyun the Ways of Survival she knew.

'That bastard. I don't know if he'll be alive.'

Lee Hakhyun wants to write the story of this world on her behalf.

Therefore, she gave him the most important story she knew.

Ooooooooooo-

The fear of something once known becoming unknown.

But Han Sooyoung was not affected by that fear. Even if she forgot the story, she was still a great writer.

The air rang menacingly. Looking at the shadows swaying beyond the hall, Han Sooyoung was vaguely able to gauge the level of 'God of the Other World'.

It wasn’t as crazy as the 'indescribable distance ' or the 'disaster' of the 999th round.

It was clear that it was at least at the level of the dream eater, and perhaps it was more than that.

Coo coo coo coo coo.

If that thing descends over Seoul, the Korean Peninsula will be destroyed. It's not just the Korean Peninsula. Maybe the Earth will become a ruin.

Nevertheless, Han Sooyoung made a shameless voice.

"Don’t bluff. You won’t be able to get over it."

As if, of course, such an ending would not come.

"Yes?"

The question was not directed to the constellations of the Emperor, nor to the incarnations on earth.

"Are you going to let it destroy your playground?"

The next moment, a portal was created in an ambiguous space neither on the ground nor in the sky.

What appeared beyond the comma-like portal was a gentleman in a black suit.

A being who refers to himself as 'Representative Kim Dokja'.

Han Sooyoung knew his true name.

"Asmodeus."

Representative Kim Dokja frowned with a light spark.

Han Sooyoung's eyes showed a strange light.

[Predictive plagiarism.]

Every sentence she read and wrote was projected onto her eyes, telling her who the being in front of her was.

"How long do you plan on playing Kim Dokja?"

【You...】

The 32nd master of the demon world, Asmodeus, the demon king of rage and lust.

In Han Sooyoung's world line, he is clearly the demon king who was destroyed by Kim Namwoon in the 999th round.

【It looks like you've already lost a lot of your memory, but my name must have been quite important, right?】

Asmodeus looked at the sparks flowing through Han Sooyoung's whole body.

Her memories were shattering through the sparks.

"I remember it well."

【You are no longer the Han Sooyoung I met before.】

Han Sooyoung held out her hand.

"Shut up and give me the 'Death Sword' you have."

She doesn't know which world it is from, but in the last fight, Asmodeus used that sword to cut her avatar link.

"If you give it to me, I'll give you what you want."

Han Sooyoung thought. All she has to do is somehow take away someone else's sword and cut off the Constellation's link that is bound to the 'Absolute Throne'.

Then, the 'God of the Other World' will lose its connection with this world, and its descent will naturally be cancelled.

To do this, she first had to persuade Asmodeus in front of her.

【Do you know what I want?】

"You don't want this world line to proceed as it should."

From the first time she faced Asmodeus, Han Sooyoung kept scoring goals.

「Why did Asmodeus move from the 3rd round to the 41st round?」

Why did he find an unrecorded world line, rather than another world line, and live as a parasite?

「Asmodeus wanted Kim Dokja, but was never able to obtain it.」

「Asmodeus used Han Myeongoh's daughter as his incarnation.」

「Asmodeus wanted to leave his name in the great legend.」

「Asmodeus was a seeker of the end.」

Countless information related to Asmodeus flowed through her mind in real time. [Predictive plagiarism] was triggered, and her consciousness flooded her mind, analyzing, synthesizing, and mixing the information.

「Asmodeus is a character who read 'Ways of Survival'.」

Han Sooyoung blinked slowly and asked.

"How did it feel to find out the identity of the world?"

Asmodeus' expression gradually hardened.

The moment she saw that expression, Han Sooyoung read the other side of that expression at once.

"You didn’t just read Ways of Survival."

Eyes that are slightly but clearly shaking.

Han Sooyoung was sure.

Asmodeus didn't just read Ways of Survival. This guy read up to Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint.

He read every sentence written for Kim Dokja and even confirmed his own death written there.

Of course, Asmodeus was not the only one who experienced such a thing. <Kim Dokja’s Company> also went through all of that.

However, Asmodeus was not <Kim Dokja’s Company>.

【What does that mean?】

He has never valued Kim Dokja, and has never dreamed of ending up with him. If such a demon king came to this world line, the reason was clear.

"You want to get out of our story, don’t you?"

【…】

"But if you stop me here, this world line will be doomed."

The course of this world is not written down, but the future is certain.

In the 41st round, Yoo Joonghyuk fails and the world line is destroyed.

And the incident in which Yoo Joonghyuk took the 'absolute throne' was the beginning of that destruction.

"You don’t want that either, do you? So help me. Let’s cooperate for a moment and I will destroy that throne, so give me the Death Sword you have."

【I don’t know what your plan is.】

After a while, Asmodeus opened his mouth.

【Why are you changing the plot now? Your purpose was to 'make this world met it’s end'.】

"…"

【Only then will your world line be safely preserved, because what you are looking for is 'Kim Dokja''s return.】

Han Sooyoung was surprised. Because she never thought that Asmodeus would already know this far.

【Is it because you saw that fragment? It is the 'fragment of Kim Dokja that you have ignored and thrown away'.】

"You are a bit noisy today. So are you going to give the sword to me or not?"

【That's funny. Why are you now paying attention to Kim Dokja, whom you abandoned? It wasn't the 'Kim Dokja' you wanted, was it?】

"If you say one more word-"

【Isn’t the Kim Dokja you want, the Kim Dokja who was the 'Demon King of Salvation'?】

With the words of Asmodeus, stories arose around him.

【He is the watcher of light and darkness.】

Kim Dokja ended the Holy Demon War and became the 'Watcher of Light and Darkness'.

【He was the successor to 'The Prisoner of the Golden Headband'.】

【And finally dreaming of this world. He has become this world itself.】

Kim Dokja, who remained in the subway when everyone else had left, became the Oldest Dream.

【Are you going to gather all those Kim Dokjas? Do you think such a thing is possible?】

"…"

【Since you use avatars, you probably know this better than anyone else.】

Han Sooyoung closed her mouth.

The ones who got angry on behalf of Han Sooyoung were the other members of <Kim Dokja's Company>.

[The constellation 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight' glares at Asmodeus.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' spits out quiet anger.]

Asmodeus spoke as if mocking <Kim Dokja's Company>.

[Are you still willing to face Kim Dokja's illusion?】

Kim Dokja of one hundred percent cannot exist. Just as she is not a 100% person now.

It wasn't a matter of whether she used an avatar or not.

All humans lose their memories every moment and become slightly different beings. The very word 100 percent was an illusion from the beginning.

So what exactly is the 'Kim Dokja' they are after?

【Or is it the will of the story that lies within you?】

Han Sooyoung looked down at her palm. It was the hand who wrote the story.

There was a story embedded in that hand.

【How are you different from the constellations you hated so much now?】

It continued to tell her story on her behalf.

[The story 'Kim Dokja's Company' looks at you.]

<Kim Dokja’s Company> was a story of people who loved Kim Dokja.

It was a story about people who gathered together for Kim Dokja and were happy only because of him.

Therefore, those who had this story inevitably had no choice but to find Kim Dokja.

"It’s already past the point where we have to consider such things."

Han Sooyoung clenched her fist filled with stories.

"Of course I know that there is no such thing as a 100% Kim Dokja."

There is no way she wouldn’t know that.

There is no way that the woman who wrote this story, and her colleagues who lived the story together, did not know that fact.

【But why do you repeat such foolish things? Why are you continuing a story that will fail?】

When they lose someone, humans go through several stages to accept the loss.

They despair over the fact that that person will never come back, but they soon come to accept that fact, and eventually live a life after his absence.

They understand that this is the natural order of the world.

That's what ordinary mourning is like.

The problem is that neither Kim Dokja nor they were ordinary human beings.

"Because I know Kim Dokja’s story."

Kim Dokja has been brought back from the dead several times.

Was the revived Kim Dokja really the same Kim Dokja as before?

If a human being, once disassembled into particles, is reassembled, will he or she be the same person as before?

Han Sooyoung did not know the answer to such a philosophical question.

However, Kim Dokja died for his companions, again and again.

He survived to protect his companions.

That “will” was Kim Dokja.

It was a story called Kim Dokja.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' nods.]

The story lacked probability. There were many loopholes and the flow was not smooth. It was full of holes here and there.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' closes its eyes.]

Such stories protected <Kim Dokja’s Company>.

He gave everything of himself and completed the ending in which everyone in the group survived.

There was no way that those who had been saved like that would be able to do anything like ordinary mourning. Those who had witnessed miracles before their eyes over and over again, and those who had survived through such stories, had no intention of meekly accepting the end.

Just as Kim Dokja tried to protect all of <Kim Dokja’s Company>, <Kim Dokja’s Company> has no choice but to find all Kim Dokja.

"Like you said, we might fail in the end."

Even if their choice now means entering a never-ending cycle.

Even if the story for only one person continues far away

If it is for Kim Dokja,

"Then we will continue to fail. That is how we honor Kim Dokja."

They will be the 'characters' of this story forever and ever.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 671 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (7)

Asmodeus, who heard Han Sooyoung's words, laughed as if it was absurd.

【Do you know what you are talking about?】

Han Sooyoung did not answer. This is because it was not something she expected him to understand in the first place.

【Are you collecting Kim Dokja's fragments for such a ridiculous reason? Trying to get 'Kim Dokja' back, who may or may not come back?】

Asmodeus sounded strangely exasperated.

【Have you ever thought about the extras who were messed up by you?】

Trampled extras.

Han Sooyoung frowned at him.

【Think about the people who sacrificed their lives for the humble cause of finding Kim Dokja. I mean, have you ever seen it?】

Asmodeus added mockingly in a somewhat theatrical tone.

【You have already distorted the world line several times. Do you really think that was the right thing to do?】

It is true that they twisted the world line several times, but the worlds they left behind were places where their destructions were all predestined, and they moved in the direction of reducing the planned great tragedy into a possible small tragedy.

That was the general principle they set.

【Does the Kim Dokja you are looking for think the same way as you? Do you think the countless Kim Dokjas who lost their sense of self in the process of collecting the fragments will support you?】

Han Sooyoung could not understand Asmodeus's words.

While collecting Kim Dokja scattered across the world, <Kim Dokja Company> never once touched a living Kim Dokja fragment.

The only things they collected were fragments wandering the universe after failing to reincarnate, and fragments of the story dropped by Kim Dokja.

"I don't know. Because I'm not Kim Dokja."

Nevertheless, Han Sooyoung did not particularly defend herself. She wondered if there was any use in saying such things. She was already used to being misunderstood.

「"You're afraid that people will still criticize you even after you defend yourself?"」

Kim Dokja was the only person who accepted Han Sooyoung as a person.

「"I'm generally a really bad person."」

「"Who decided this?"」

What would Kim Dokja say if he saw her now?

Asmodeus spoke as if he knew the answer.

【If you're going to say something so shamelessly, you have to be shameless until the end. At first, you said you would make the world be destroyed as planned, but now you're going to change the planned development?】

"That-"

【Have you changed your mind after seeing 49% of Kim Dokja?】

49% of Kim Dokja.

Han Sooyoung's eyes slightly wavered because she didn't know that Asmodeus knew that.

【Did you feel sorry for Kim Dokja, whom you abandoned?】

Even Han Sooyoung, who rarely gets embarrassed, couldn't help but be shaken by that one word.

Two other people got angry in her stead.

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' what you know…]

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' with a beautiful expression…]

"Lee Gilyoung. Yoo Sangah."

At Han Sooyoung's words, the constellations' indirect messages faded away.

Han Sooyoung continued speaking.

"Yes, you're not wrong. In the end, I couldn't save that guy."

Han Sooyoung remembered the story of 49% Kim Dokja.

She wondered if he was born as something other than Kim Dokja.

In the end, the guy who got his wish and got a new name, 'Lee Hakhyun'.

For some reason, he returned to the world that made him 'Kim Dokja'.

「"This kind of conclusion is unacceptable."」

This time, not as a 'reader', but as a writer who writes stories.

"What has already happened cannot be undone. All I can send now are lame excuses."

【I am not curious about your circumstances.】

"But I'm still the author of this story."

What does it mean to write a 'story' in this world?

By changing one line, what is it like to handle the responsibilities that follow?

Because she understood the weight better than anyone else, Han Sooyoung decided to pick up the pen before Lee Hakhyun.

"I will destroy the absolute throne."

At least so that Lee Hakhyun does not feel guilty for causing the tragedy.

"Whether the world line is twisted or the universe is destroyed, I take responsibility for that too."

That was the only gift she could give to 49% Kim Dokja and writer Lee Hakhyun.

【Hmm, I can't give you the Death Sword as expected.】

Asmodeus shrugged his shoulders at Han Sooyoung as if mocking her, then turned around gracefully and said,

【Because this story is no longer your story. Now, don't you think so too?】

Han Sooyoung furrowed her eyebrows.

Either way, Asmodeus continued to talk loudly. It was as if someone was listening to him and his next words.

【Do you want to know now? What kind of person is 'Han Sooyoung'? How arbitrary and selfish you are. How deadly a being is in this universe.】

The space behind Asmodeus began to tremble.

As the space swayed like a silver screen in the wind, it soon illuminated the audience seats of the theater.

Auditorium that can seat hundreds of people

"You-"

Kkomas Kim Dokja were sitting in the audience.

"Are you collecting living souls?"

Asmodeus answered Han Sooyoung, who was swallowing her burning anger.

【Alive? Aren't these all the readers you killed?】

"What nonsense-"

Han Sooyoung looked at the kkoma Kim Dokja in the audience. A number so large that it cannot be contained at a glance. The number was greater than all the readers in this world combined.

No way?

The moment when Han Sooyoung, who was in great shape, was about to open her mouth to Asmodeus.

「"What are you going to do if you go through the first portal and find Kim Dokja again, who is not good enough? Are you going to believe that the dog is Kim Dokja this time?"」

A familiar story was heard from somewhere.

「"And the fragments of Kim Dokja who imagined that kind of ending, I will go to each and every one of them and torment them until they come up with a proper ending."」

These were all things she said.

「"I'm going to catch that guy somehow and bring him back. 49%, 51%, I'm tired of playing games of numbers. I have to get 100% now."」

After hearing her story, kkomas Kim Dokja were asking her questions.

「Why did you throw away 49%?」

Her hair stood up. A chill that feels like it's freezing to the bone. It seemed as if the entire world was against her.

Han Sooyoung resisted the fear and opened her mouth.

She didn't give up.

She wanted to say that. But she couldn't write down her words.

The probability of the Star Stream was holding her back.

Asmodeus laughed.

【Do you understand now?】

Amidst the sound of the projector running, the questions of kkomas Kim Dokja resounded like a spinning song.

「Why did you throw him away?」

Han Sooyoung realized.

'It seems that they have the same thoughts as him.'

This story has been going according to Asmodeus's script for a long time.

「"They are no longer Kim Dokja. They are people who were living in a different world. They each had their own lives."」

「"You called me."」

「"I didn’t call you, though?"」

What she didn't do.

「"Do you think the countless Kim Dokjas who lost their sense of self in the process of collecting Kim Dokja’s fragments will also support your cause?"」

What <Kim Dokja Company> did not do.

「"That guy can’t be the Kim Dokja we know."」

A piece of truth cleverly mixed on top of lies. The story is complete.

"What on earth have you done?"

Han Sooyoung stumbled and looked at her audience.

[The story 'Kim Dokja’s Company' begins its storytelling.]

She wanted to let them know.

What you saw wasn't everything. All those words probably didn't mean what you understood.

「"That guy can’t be the Kim Dokja we know."」

Han Sooyoung clearly said that.

「"Just as the 1,863-round me is not the Han Sooyoung you all know."」

In order to properly face the 49% Kim Dokja, they had to admit that he was not the Kim Dokja they knew.

Han Sooyoung said that was the way to treat 49% Kim Dokja as a proper person.

She believed it.

She wrote it from the perspective of an Omniscient Reader. These were sentences that were not written in.

1%, 49%, 51%.

As long as they are <Kim Dokja’s Company>, there is no Kim Dokja who is not precious to them.

She could have said that over and over again. The fact that there is a Kim Dokja in this world that they are looking for does not mean that they are turning away from other Kim Dokjas.

An 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint', she didn't write those words down.

This is because it was not a sentence for just one person, Kim Dokja.

And 49% of Kim Dokja said,

「"I’m sorry."」

Kim Dokja wanted to be the one and only Kim Dokja.

「"I’m sorry, Han Sooyoung."」

Since that couldn't happen, he left them.

He quit being Kim Dokja.

"Kim Dokja, I-"

Han Sooyoung opened her mouth for the first time to defend herself.

They too would understand if they were 'Kim Dokja'. They will understand.

After listening to her story, they will definitely change their mind.

Tsutsutsutsu.

She had to tell a story. She had to write here some sentences that she didn't write down back then.

But she couldn't think of anything.

Han Sooyoung looked blankly at the place where the story existed.

Memories that disappeared when her [Avatar] disappeared.

The only sentences that could persuade readers.

She has now lost those sentences forever.

【This world is such a story. Do you understand?】

Asmodeus was laughing.

【This world does not want you. Because you are the villains of this world.】

It was all viewpoints.

Kkoma Kim Dokja is a very small fragment of 'Kim Dokja'. In other words, the stories they read and believe in become the power of this world.

It becomes probable.

Tsutsutsutsutsu-

The brilliant aura that flowed from the center of the theater was the right hand of Asmodeus.

【So, please stop and die.】

Han Sooyoung saw Asmodeus like that, and saw the readers beyond him, and she thought of the one person who would be watching this whole story.

"Good."

Han Sooyoung laughed.

"After all, I've always been the villain."

As she took a deep breath, she could feel her broken body. Now, the probability that was given to her was limited.

[The constellation 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight'...]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer'...]

But she was still a writer, and she still had stories to tell.

「"Maybe Kim Dokja's tastes have changed? The stories you wrote are no longer interesting."」

Remembering Lee Hakhyun's words, Han Sooyoung held on tightly to the Unbreakable Faith left behind by Kim Dokja.

What kind of story did Kim Dokja want to see when he came here?

She does not know.

Perhaps even Kim Dokja himself doesn't know.

He is the most helpless god in this universe, unable to do anything but read and reread one story.

"Go for it, Asmodeus."

Han Sooyoung decided to begin her final story for her god.

She said, "Because this time I will take your breath away."

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rlaehrwk37: Save me Kim Dokja

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I ran through the wind and rain.

Black and blue lightning struck continuously in the dark cloud-covered sky.

All kinds of thoughts ran through my head.

Maybe it's already too late.

If it is not too late, what can we do to stop Yoo Joonghyuk?

As I ran until my thighs exploded, I thought of the 'Ways of Survival' in my head.

Just as Kim Dokja came up with the 'Ways of Survival' whenever he got stuck in a scenario.

[The skill cannot currently be activated.]

Ways of Survival was blocked. Why?

I had an ominous feeling. Deafening thunder shook the entire area.

Bright blue thunderbolts falling one after another.

A huge and probable aftermath was brewing.

There was an incarnation glimpsed in the center of the storm.

I muttered her name absentmindedly.

"Han Sooyoung?"

Her body, which had turned pitch black, was falling to the ground.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 672 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (8)

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With the explosion, thick dust rose from the ground.

"Han Sooyoung!"

I ran to the center of Gwanghwamun where Han Sooyoung fell. No matter how many times I shouted, there was no answer from Han Sooyoung.

Coo coo coo coo.

The 'Absolute Throne' at the center of Gwanghwamun was rising into the air.

【Ooooooooooooo.】

A faint cry was heard from far away.

It was undoubtedly a deity from another world.

Fortunately, the sound was too far away so I didn't vomit blood or faint, but the seriousness of the situation was clear.

「This is something that did not happen in the previous 'Absolute Throne''s scenario.」

The outer gods' intervened.

Did Han Sooyoung fight something like that?

Why?

Hasn't she been trying to destroy this world?

"Han Sooyoung!"

I shouted once again, but Han Sooyoung was still nowhere to be seen. When the dust cleared, I saw the figure of Yoo Joonghyuk in the distance.

The guy was in a limp state, as if he had fainted.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body was connected to a red thread extending from the 'Absolute Throne'.

The soaring Absolute Throne and the fallen Yoo Joonghyuk.

Very slowly, the distance between Yoo Joonghyuk and the throne was narrowing.

[The 'Throne Succession Ceremony' begins.]

The series of constellations continued.

Founder of the Absolute Throne. It was the will of that outer god.

"Hey, look at that!"

"It’s Yoo Joonghyuk!"

The surrounding incarnations, who discovered the sight belatedly, shouted loudly.

["Wow, things are getting fun. Then, we will come to the finale of this scenario."]

To make matters worse, the dokkaebi Paul appeared and activated a sub-scenario.

[A new sub-scenario has arrived.]

**<Sub Scenario - Stealing the Throne>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: A

Clear Condition: A new king will soon be born on the Korean Peninsula. Subdue Yoo Joonghyuk, the incarnation who is trying to sit on the throne, and usurp the 'absolute throne'.

Time limit: 30 minutes

Reward: 7,000 coins

Failure: —

[Now, everyone. This is your last chance. Will you witness the king's coronation, or will you become the usurper of the throne?]

The intermediate dokkaebi burst into laughter as if enjoying this whole situation.

[The constellation 'Bald General of Justice' diligently wipes his head.]

[The constellation 'Maritime War God' sighs and looks at the throne.]

[The constellation 'Founder of Hangul' is silent with a sad face.]

[The constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' stares at the god of the other world.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' mocks that no one has courage!]

Although the constellations were afraid of the scenery, they did not take their eyes off it.

Even though the scenario was presented, none of the incarnations moved easily.

It was natural.

The person who inherits the throne now is the supreme incarnation, Yoo Joonghyuk.

There was no one who could challenge him, who single-handedly overthrew all kings.

Only one person.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Except me.

"Yoo Joonghyuk! Get some sleep! If you sit there, it’s all over!"

I headed toward the throne, defeated the crowd, and approached the throne.

It must be stopped. It can be prevented. It is not too late.

"Ahjussi."

What held me back was that.

"That’s it."

A slender girl holding a long sword.

"Lee Jihye."

Yoo Joonghyuk's royal guard was blocking the path leading to the throne.

"Now, if you cross this line, you’ll die, you know?"

Delusion Demon Kim Namwoon.

In addition, there were groups of people who followed the king.

"The king! Supreme King!"

"He is the new king of the Korean Peninsula!"

A woman with her white hair disheveled was also seen in the center of the group.

Incarnation Lee Seolhwa.

I realized it again.

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round has already gathered so many colleagues.

This guy didn't rest for a single moment, and was steadily taking steps toward the end of this world.

"I said you couldn’t go."

As soon as I took a decisive step, Lee Jihye pulled out her sword. It wasn't just a threat. If I go one step further now, I will definitely get cut.

Lightning struck from the sky, revealing the appearance of Yoo Joonghyuk, who was much closer to the throne.

Han Sooyoung probably fought to stop it on her own.

The last time I met Han Sooyoung, I spoke smugly to her.

I am also the author of this story.

I'll try to convince you.

I will complete the story you wrote.

So what was the story I wrote?

I looked around Gwanghwamun.

Everything was in ruins.

Dying incarnations wriggled on the floor. The stars in the sky twinkled as if they were mocking me.

I thought I could do well.

I believed I knew the whole story too.

[The exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' activates intermittently.]

Sentences of 'Ways of Survival' heard rarely.

Perhaps this skill is a memory Han Sooyoung gave me.

I smiled bitterly out of frustration.

If I didn't have this skill, I would have died early.

As I slowly took another step forward, Lee Jihye’s sword, which had been pulled out at the same time, reached me.

"If you move any further, I’ll have no choice but to cut you down."

While Yoo Joonghyuk was building his story, where and what was I doing?

「Obviously, there were a lot of stories I wanted to tell.」

I wanted to talk about characters who didn't receive attention in the main story. The lives of extras. I wanted to write a story for those who were forgotten in Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint and could not leave a single line of sentences.

I wanted to save Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st round.

「Was any of them correct?」

For the first time, I realized my lack of talent as a writer.

"I am."

「I couldn't change this story.」

I took one more step, looking straight at Lee Jihye's sword.

「If this is my karma for ruining the story.」

Lee Jihye's eyes, having decided on something, were colored with a harsh light. The moment when the girl's sword rushed towards me with the sound of cutting the wind.

"Jihye-ssi."

Someone grabbed Lee Jihye's blade.

"Please let Inho-ssi pass."

She was a woman shorter than me.

"Inho-ssi has work to do."

The moment I heard her voice, a small warmth lingered deep in my heart.

[Fable 'Recorder of things that will disappear' begins its storytelling.]

Warmth soon became a sentence.

「The reader who was more scared than anyone else was there.」

Kyung Sein. The second reader I met. Among the characters, the person who likes Jung Heewon the most. He is someone who grew up because he wanted to become strong like Lee Hyunsung.

He must have suffered so much during this time that his body was full of wounds.

"Sein-ssi."

With a trembling body, Kyung Sein looked back at me.

"Inho-ssi."

No matter how strong Kyung Sein became, his opponent was the protagonist of this story.

There is no match for him physically.

Nevertheless, Kyung Sein did not back down.

"I don’t want to see this world destroyed."

Lee Jihye's expression hardened towards me, who listened to those words blankly.

"Are you going to fight us now?"

Her cold magic boiled over in her swordplay. This sword of wisdom, imbued with a deep blue sword, moved.

"Do you know how strong I am?"

If you get hit by something like that, no matter how powerful you are, you cannot avoid fatal injuries.

The moment Kyung Sein, embarrassed, hugged me and bent down, someone struck Lee Jihye's sword and derailed its trajectory. Someone kicked Lee Jihye’s blade.

"What-"

Lee Jihye stepped away while holding her wrist. Kim Namwoon, who was watching the scene, smiled with a happy attitude.

"Oh, what? This is getting fun?"

「There was a reader there who had read more novels than anyone else.」

Literature Girl 64.

Cha Yerin activated [combat action mode] and struck down Lee Jihye's sword.

"Yerin. What is the time limit?"

"3 minutes."

"We have to finish it within that time."

"That’s enough."

「There was a reader there who wanted to be Yoo Joonghyuk more than anyone else.」

Killer King Ja Sungwoo stretched out his hand to me who was sitting on the floor and said.

"Wake up, Kim Dokja."

Even during this time, I stood up while holding his hand, who did not lose sight of the concept.

Lee Jihye growled.

"Are you serious? Do you all want to die?"

"No one wants to die."

「There was a reader there who wanted to see the ending of this world without sacrificing anyone.」

Lee Dansu, who was carrying Shin Yoosung, put his hand on my shoulder and said,

"Everyone gathered here so that no one would die."

What was so funny about those words? Kim Namwoon, the delusional demon, burst out laughing.

"Hahaha! That’s fun! It’s something you often see in novels."

For a moment, the delusional demon’s sword made a sharp sound and looked at us. Magical power overflowed throughout his body.

"Tell me some great lines like that too, huh?"

As the delusional demon approached in an instant and stretched out his fist, Yerin's body floated in the air.

Kim Namwoon laughed after blocking the arrow fired by the enraged Killer King with his forearm.

"That toy looks fun."

Black Flame stretched out from Kim Namwoon's hand and burned Killer King's bowgun. What saved the siblings, who were suddenly in danger, was a bullet flying from somewhere.

"Second apostle! Get down!"

「There was also a reader there who was more rational than anyone else, but was actually more passionate than anyone else.」

The smoke from the cannonballs covered the area along with the sound of doo-doo-doo-doo.

Ye Hyunwoo ran through the dust and supported his companions. Gong Pildu covered behind him. I also saw Max the dog barking next to me.

"Pierce it! You must never give up the throne!"

With Ye Hyeonwoo's command, the troops of Chungmuro ran shouting.

But the opponents were Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon.

"Let's go!"

"Kaaaaaaak!"

People who lost limbs in a single slash screamed. Cha Yerin and Killer King. Lee Dansu and Kyung Sein also joined.

However, they have already overcome the scenario and have exhausted a lot of their stamina.

There was no way they could properly deal with Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon.

"Inho-ssi, run!"

I ran on the path that they had made for me.

Lee Jihye shouted.

I left behind the dizzying fear of life and quickened my steps. Even though I broke through the two lines of resistance, there were still many troops protecting Yoo Joonghyuk.

All of this was the history built up by Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round.

"Stop him."

Following Lee Seolhwa's self-righteous command, Yoo Joonghyuk’s followers waved their military flags.

"Kill him! He’s trying to assassinate the king!"

Even if [Incite] was used, it was a difficult number to handle. To force these people to step down through [Incite], I may not have enough magic power to destroy the 'absolute throne'.

It was then that a disturbing noise was heard from the left side of the troops.

"Kaaaaaaaa! What!"

A crowd was running, breaking the ranks of followers.

"Aaaah! Brother Inho!"

A man who bumped his body here and there and pushed in like a tank.

A mother and daughter were also seen swinging kitchen knives to the left and right of the man.

"Bang Cheolsoo!"

As if responding to my shout, Bang Cheolsoo opened the road with a loud shout.

"Go!"

The way to the absolute throne was opened.

「The people that Lee Hakhyun saved were there.」

I ran the road they opened for me.

「As if to say that his story is not wrong.」

The people who lived such a sloppy story. Those who willingly accepted the clumsy changes I wrote, opened the path for me to run.

It was then that something crashed into the center of the road.

A spirit that takes your breath away just by looking at it. A huge shadow as if Mount Tai was blocking my view.

"Inho-ssi. I can't allow you to advance any more."

Yoo Joonghyuk's strongest shield, Lee Hyunsung.

His large right hand moved towards my head. It was [Smashing Mount Tai].

I instinctively raised my magic power. If I am hit by that attack, I will be at least seriously injured.

I quickly lowered my head to avoid his right hand. But his left hand was waiting below him. The [Taesan Push] embedded in the shield was pushed exactly in the direction I was avoiding. It was an unavoidable blow. The moment I opened my mouth to activate [Incite].

A loud noise exploded before my eyes.

When I rolled on the floor and looked forward, the first thing I saw was Lee Hyunsung's shocked face.

"How-"

The steel shield that Lee Hyunsung was holding was split in half and rolling on the floor. Something had pushed Lee Hyunsung's attack and shattered his shield.

I also understood his feelings.

At this point, the only incarnation with that level of power is Yoo Joonghyuk.

「And there was a sword protecting him.」

However, in this 41st round, there was another incarnation with such power.

"Look at this. This is what happens when you leave me and go alone."

The only incarnation in this world who is not afraid of Yoo Joonghyuk's sword.

「The only sword that protected Kim Dokja in the third world line.」

I said her name.

"Heewon-ssi."

"I'll ask you what happened later, so get up first. There's something you have to do, right?"

Jung Heewon, the judge of destruction, raised me up and spoke.

"Do your job. I will deal with that big guy."

"Stop!"

Lee Hyunsung stretched out his hand in embarrassment, and Jung Heewon swung her sword at him.

The strongest sword and the strongest shield collided, causing harsh vibrations to echo throughout the area.

After leaving the fight between the two behind, I looked up into the sky.

The distance between the absolute throne that was soaring high into the sky and Yoo Joonghyuk was not much now.

There was no time to hesitate.

"I will receive a hidden scenario reward."

[Pending 'Hidden Scenario' rewards will be paid.]

[You have hunted a disaster for the first time in a scenario!]

[An incredible achievement has been achieved!]

[90,000 coins were obtained!]

…

[The management bureau grants you a scenario privilege.]

[You can choose one of the items below as a reward.]

**[Black Flame Half Armor: SSS grade]**

[Sylphid's Leaping Boots: SSS grade]

[Fire Dragon Egg: SS grade]

…

A mental list of perk items.

I answered without even reading the entire list.

"Sylphid’s Leaping Boots."

An item that Kim Dokja did not choose. But for me now, it was an item I needed more than anything else.

[Obtained 'Sylphid’s Leaping Boots '!]

My toes felt cool and a gentle breeze wrapped around my ankles.

[Special option: Activates leap.]

I just stepped into the air with all my might. As I rose all the way to the sky, Yoo Joonghyuk was finally right in front of me.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

Now I have arrived.

However, I was not yet ready to crush the absolute throne. This was because there was no one to speak up for the proclaimers.

So, for now, I grabbed Yoo Joonghyuk. I thought it was distance that separated him from the throne, but the moment I held on to the guy's arm with all my strength, the space in front of my eyes suddenly shuddered.

[The 'Theatre of the Beginning' is activated.]

My vision swirled as if I was being sucked into a wall. When I came to my senses from dizziness. I was thrown into an unfamiliar place.

—Yoo Joonghyuk! Yoo Joonghyuk!

—Now the era of supremacy begins!

People's shouts heard through old speakers. I blinked and saw a huge screen. The scenery of Gwanghwamun was projected on the screen.

I looked at the scene blankly and slowly turned my head.

The familiar darkness of the theater captivated me. Hundreds of seats that glow in the dark. Hundreds of readers occupied those seats.

【You've finally arrived.】

The kkomas Kim Dokja were looking at me. Some have a flushed face, some have a sad face.

In the center of them, someone was talking and clapping his hands at the wall.

【Our abandoned protagonist.】

As expected, he was someone I knew well.

Representative Kim Dokja stood up with a face full of joy and said.

【Let us welcome '49% Kim Dokja' with joy.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 673 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (9)

I stared blankly at the audience, like an actor who forgot his lines.

What did I just hear?

【I can't tell you how fortunate I am that you came to this world line. Don’t we all think so?】

The kkomas Kim Dokja didn't answer anything. Just looking at me without saying anything positive or negative.

Representative Kim Dokja laughed as if he was happy about that.

【Could it be that he still doesn’t know who he is?】

At Representative Kim Dokja's words, languid sighs came from all over the audience.

[The story 'Recorder of Things that will Disappear' begins its storytelling.]

I looked back at the screen. The stories of the lives of myself and the readers were displayed on the screen.

But that wasn't the whole story.

Like the shadows reflected on the cave walls, some scenes were abnormally exaggerated and others were cut out.

The story on the screen was more exciting than the reality I felt, and the target of my anger was clear.

A narrative of good and punishment with clear good and bad roles.

"Has our story been shown this way all this time?"

The image on the screen stopped along with my question. While the kkomas Kim Dokja were talking loudly, Representative Kim Dokja took a step forward.

When I think about it, I still don't know Representative Kim Dokja's purpose. I didn't really know why he brought the readers here or why he was confronting <Kim Dokja's Company>.

【You're right. Because I have to write a 'new story'.】

New story.

Representative Kim Dokja was looking at Yoo Joonghyuk who had fallen on the floor.

【And a 'new story' needs a 'new protagonist'.】

With a beeping sound, the image on the screen changed.

【I remember the first time I saw you.】

What was shown on the screen was the scenery of Geumho Station.

The first scenario, which I also know well - the scene of 'proving our worth'.

「Kim Cheolyang's head exploded with the sound of bub bub buk.」

The people of Geumho Station, Kim Cheolyang and the Life Church were dying after being deceived.

The screen showed a close-up of my facial expression as I smiled in inexplicable joy at the exact moment they died.

For a moment, I had nothing to say.

Clearly the story on this screen has been edited. Nevertheless, that expression was clearly mine.

【Your arrival wasn't something I had planned, but now I think it worked out well.】

The screen kept changing.

A scene which development changed when we met Bang Cheolsoo's gang at Geumho Station.

「"Prove it once."」

The scene where I met Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round and fell into the Han River.

「"It’s definitely Cheon Inho. Then it won’t matter if this woman dies."」

The scene of escaping with Jung Heewon, who has awakened as judge.

[Incarnation 'Jung Heewon'’s characteristics blossom into the character Destroying Judge (Hero).]

The scene where I met the Killer King siblings, defeated the 'Dark Sentinel', and gained 'thoughts of almost everything'.

「"Cheon Inho!"」

When I met Anna Croft in 'Welcome Prison' and confirmed the past of Cheon Inho from the 40th round.

「"The moment you press the reset button, this world does not disappear, but becomes eternal."」

The scene where I met the Seven Apostle Ye Hyunwoo and Gong Pildu in Chungmuro.

「"Cheon In-ho looks like this... He's much more handsome than what I read."」

In the 'Emergency Defense Battle', saving Max by pushing him to the ground.

「"If the monsters hadn’t died here, would this story have been really interesting."」

While clearing the scenario of the theater dungeon, the reader Jung Jaewoo was lost.

「"I don't want to die."」

Until I finally got to the rooftop of the theater and came face to face with Han Sooyoung.

「"Really, is it Han Sooyoung?"」

For a moment, I even forgot about my situation and was absorbed in the memory. It occurred to me that a lot had happened in a short period of time.

There were memories missing between scenes. Memories that are not written down anywhere but remain intact in my head.

The video stopped again and Representative Kim Dokja opened his mouth.

【Because you are the one best suited to end their story.】

I couldn’t figure out who 'they' was referring to.

Did it refer to the characters who died in this rounds, or —when I turned my head, the kkomas Kim Dokja were looking at the screen with their mouths open.

What is written is not everything.

But that doesn't mean that what they saw was a lie.

The kkomas Kim Dokja had a somewhat nostalgic look in their eyes.

I took a deep breath and opened my mouth.

"I’m the main character."

It was a funny story.

If they make a movie with me as the main character, it will 100% fail.

"If you were secretly filming a movie like that, shouldn’t you have gotten my permission first?"

Representative Kim Dokja’s eyes widened at my obvious voice.

"If you’re going to do something like that, first pay the price."

I don't know what they plan to do with me as the main character, but from my point of view, it was best to take advantage of this situation as much as possible. My goal now is to destroy the 'absolute throne.' If I can-

【Haha-】

"…?"

【Ahaha. Ahahahahah!】

A sound of laughter that seems to be driven by mania. Representative Kim Dokja was not the only one laughing.

A few kkomas Kim Dokja were also smiling as if they were having fun.

【Sorry. It's such a hateful and nostalgic reaction.】

"What?

【Great. I'll pay the price. Is this enough?】

[You have won 300,000 coins!]

Coins suddenly poured out of thin air. I looked up into space blankly as golden waves scattered out of nowhere. I had a feeling that something was going wrong.

【By the way. I need to make sure I hired the right actor.】

After a moment of hesitation, his cool tone penetrated my heart.

【Kim Dokja.】

Just a three letter name.

Why does that name that I have called, read, and used countless times sound so painful?

[The attribute 'He who peered into the abyss' is activated.]

I felt dizzy for a moment.

It felt like my body was being sucked down, as if someone had grabbed my ankle and pulled me down.

Not long ago, a memory came to mind when people incited me to be 'Kim Dokja'.

I had a similar experience back then as I do now.

My soul was sucked into the depths of the ocean, like an abyss, and there I heard the stories of readers.

But what I heard there weren’t just readers’ stories.

The image on the screen changed.

「"The person who will read my novel... is not you."」

Kim Dokja spoke in his memory, along with the painful voice of a familiar person and blood drops bouncing on the screen.

「"Han Sooyoung. I'm sorry, but I really don't remember. These days, I also haven't read Ways of Survival."」

'Maybe I really thought, 'maybe it’s not Kim Dokja'.'

<Kim Dokja Company> said.

「"Dokja, can you stand up for a moment? If you keep lying down, your back will be ruined."」

「"How about doing gymnastics with me?"」

「"Is it okay, Ahjussi? I'll at least bring a pack of stories."」

Memories with them.

「"Wow, that's the method you used?"」

「"This recipe was taught to me by a man."」

「"Did you always do all this alone?"」

At the end of the scenario, Kim Dokja was speaking.

「"The other me might not want this. The story... that's where it ended..."」

I was thinking again.

「If I could be reborn, I hope I won’t be Kim Dokja.」

A distant meteor flew with a halo of light. The world became wider and narrower in an instant.

A pale, blue planet.

A meteor fell.

「"I also want to have my own story."」

A child born where the meteor fell burst into tears.

I watched myself crying in my parents' arms for a long time.

【Are you still going to deny who you are?】

"…"

【Aren't you angry? Why did you have to suffer so much?】

【Why did you have to be denounced as a 'fake' and have your position taken away?】

His voice was like a narration heard among distant stars.

【Don't you think we should take revenge on them?】

Memories that come to mind even if I try to deny them.

As several kkomas Kim Dokja shook their heads, sparks flew in the air.

Representative Kim Dokja spoke.

【Now it's your turn.】

His eyes were burning, as if he had been waiting for this moment.

【Prove that you were real. Defeat Kim Dokja's Company and free this world line from their long and boring story. It's about creating the extra paradise you've dreamed of.】

Just then, Yoo Joonghyuk, who had fallen to the floor, wriggled slightly. It seemed like he was slowly regaining consciousness.

【Please stop Yoo Joonghyuk. I will lend you the probability that you are lacking.】

I came here to stop Yoo Joonghyuk. To prevent him from attaining the 'absolute throne' and thus prevent this world's destruction.

【This is your last chance to change the foundation of the universe that oppresses you.】

The foundation of the universe.

The moment I heard those words, I slowly came to my senses. Han Sooyoung's words came to mind.

「"I have come to the 'conclusion' of all these stories. To stop this damn tragedy that won't end!"」

At that time, I was angry after hearing Han Sooyoung's words.

I wanted to ask her why she was stopping me, since they were the ones who twisted the world line of the 'Ways of Survival'.

The people of this world line also deserve to be happy.

Extras in this world also deserve to live their own lives.

Even if the end of this world is predetermined, I wanted to say that it is not a world that she can destroy without care. However,

「Why did Han Sooyoung try to destroy this world?」

The events of this world line occurred but were not recorded.

Everything that happened in this world serves to fill the empty link between 'Ways of Survival' and 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

But what would happen if the ending of this world line changed?

【Now, we are destroying the universe of Kim Dokja's Company.】

I looked down at the theater floor. The floor is tangled with countless footprints of kkomas Kim Dokja.

【The basis of the <Star Stream>, which ruled your fate. It will destroy the ending of the world that only Kim Dokja knew.】

In a corner of my heart, this feeling grew stronger.

Maybe I'm wrong.

Even if the ending of this world changes, the world of <Kim Dokja's Company> may be safe.

Just a branch of a new parallel universe will be born.

It may end with this.

But if that's not the case.

If in return for changing the ending, all the world lines of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 are destroyed.

「What if that was the reason Han Sooyoung tried to stop me?」

When I suddenly raised my head, Representative Kim Dokja was approaching in front of me.

Above his outstretched hand was a sword emitting a dazzling fan.

【Please take it.】

A sword that will change the ending of this world.

It was not the non-awakened 'Death Sword' that I had, but a holy relic Death Sword that had fully awakened.

An item with a medium-sized story shining above the engraved constellations, which can take down the 'absolute throne' right away.

【It's time to end their story with your own hands.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 674 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (10)

"I am."

A thought suddenly occurred to me.

This world is a huge mess.

Depending on who the speaker is, this world becomes a different story and a different reality. And I,

"I cannot receive that sword."

Unfortunately, the reality I believed in was different from that of Representative Kim Dokja.

Representative Kim Dokja's eyebrows furrowed greatly at my reaction.

【That's strange.】

An expression that seemed either puzzled or expected.

【Haven't you always wanted to have your own story?】

In a way, he was right.

Because I am a person who wants my own story, both as a writer and as a reader.

However, right now, I needed to put the boiling memories to rest for a while.

"Why is Representative Kim Dokja trying to make me take this role now?"

I looked at his whole body with fixed eyes. Even at a glance, the level of dignity emanating from him was at an unusual level. If he wanted to, he could destroy the 'Absolute Throne' himself.

But he didn't do that.

Exactly, it cannot be done.

This is probably because, like other constellations, he is affected by the aftereffects of probability.

Even 'Representative Kim Dokja', who has such a powerful status, intervened in the scenario and to destroy the 'absolute throne'.

I can't break it.

So he lends me his power.

It was clear what he wanted in return.

「A story.」

A story that is completed by destroying the absolute throne. This guy is trying to get his share of the story.

Now that I think about it, there was a person similar to him in Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

A being who helped Kim Dokja and received a share of the huge story 'Spring of the Demon World' in return for lending his power to him.

【Hmm.】

The demonic energy flowing from his entire body became hostile for a moment.

I reflexively pulled Yoo Joonghyuk, who had fallen to the floor.

Coo coo coo coo.

As soon as I used his body as a shield, a surge of demonic energy shook the entire theater. Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body trembled like an aspen tree as he was struck by the wave of demonic energy on my behalf.

Yoo Joonghyuk, whose eyes were wide open, glared at me with astonished eyes and then fainted.

Representative Kim Dokja stared at us closely and then laughed.

【No matter how you look at what he's doing, it's Kim Dokja.】

"I'm sorry."

There was no need to show courtesy any more. Because I fully knew that his intentions were impure.

Now I was ready to tell my story.

"I am not Kim Dokja."

I looked at each of the kkomas Kim Dokja and said,

"My name is Lee Hakhyun."

Kkomas Kim Dokja looked at me and tilted their heads and nodded as if they understood. Some showed no reaction at all.

Representative Kim Dokja said.

【That's not the answer we wanted.】

"I guess that's not the answer you wanted."

Representative Kim Dokja twitched the corner of his mouth as if he was interested.

I didn't miss the opportunity and spoke.

"Is it real or fake, revenge or liberation? The words are plausible. But."

I also knew the story of 49% Kim Dokja.

Among the memories I saw, there were also memories that Representative Kim Dokja did not show.

But even if those memories were suddenly my past life, it doesn't feel real.

It was true.

Just as Kim Dokja cannot become Yoo Joonghyuk just because he read a lot of 'Ways of Survival'.

To me, 49% Kim Dokja's story had a distant corner, like a story beyond a wall.

And even if my past life was really that of Kim Dokja—

"Why are you angry on behalf of Kim Dokja?"

The thing that represents that will should not be the thing in front of me.

"Whether he blames <Kim Dokja's Company> or gets angry and takes revenge, that's up to Kim Dokja to decide, at least not for you.

Besides, you don't really sympathize with Kim Dokja. You just want to steal Kim Dokja's story. Just like you did in the last world, in this world you just—"

The demonic energy that slowly flowed out of this guy climbed up the top of my foot like a bug.

But I didn't stop talking.

"You just want to remain as the main story of this world."

Perhaps it was a switch, but the smile on his lips became clear. It was a smile when I felt something different from before.

【Still, I had expectations from you...】

My body stiffened and did not move.

I couldn't tell if it was because of the man's terrible murderous intent or because of his selfishness.

【Let's resume screening.】

The kkomas Kim Dokja who were watching me were suddenly looking at the screen behind me instead of at me.

As I moved my creaking neck and followed his gaze, I saw my image reflected on the screen.

I spoke on the screen.

「"I will accept the Death Sword."」

With a faint sigh, I held the Death Sword on the screen. When I looked forward again, I was actually holding the 'Death Sword' held out by Representative Kim Dokja in my hand.

My body was moving against my will.

[The 'Beginning Theater' resumes screening.]

Only then did I realize the rules of this 'theater'.

Representative Kim Dokja's ability is editing and manipulating images on the screen. And the power of this theater was to develop the story.

However, this level of abnormal coercion clearly defies probability—

[You have received 300,000 coins in return.]

[Your body follows the narration’s commands.]

Damn it. Was it something like that?

【The scenario has already been completed. Please accept your role obediently.】

My joints creaked like a broken doll.

I looked down at Yoo Joonghyuk, who had fainted.

The sword held in my right hand cried. The story of the other world embedded in the sword was giving orders.

「Cut it.」

I held the sword with both hands.

「The air.」

A faint string of constellations was visible above Yoo Joonghyuk's head.

That thread would be the link to the 'Absolute Throne'.

【It's for the future of this world.】

Both hands were shaking violently. My strength to not cut and the power of the story to cut were clashing.

If I relax now, many people in this world may be saved.

Not everyone will survive until the final scenario, but at least we will not live in a world where the 'end' is confirmed.

But if that happens, what happens to the characters in other universes?

<Kim Dokja's Company> has repeatedly made a long pilgrimage looking only at Kim Dokja.

What happens at the end?

Is this really the story everyone wants?

The muscles all over my body throbbed as if they were being twisted. Blood appeared in both eyes, and it hurt like someone was squeezing my abdomen. The magic flowing through my veins was boiling as if it were expanding.

「Cut it.」

I was seeing myself moving in real time on the screen.

All the stories shown in this movie theater are fabricated according to Representative Kim Dokja's wishes.

However, he did not have the power to make that story a reality.

I mustered the last of my strength and looked back at my audience.

There were readers there.

The readers all had the same face, but wore different name tags.

Among them, there must be Jung Jaewoo, whom I could not protect.

There will be Jiwoon, the daughter of Lee Dansu, and there will also be a reader who possessed Jung Moonho, the father of Jung Heewon.

They were innocent people.

People who became the audience just because they read this story.

In return for simply learning Kim Dokja's story, they are now deprived of the freedom to see what they want.

「Perhaps there is only one way to solve it.」

I slowly opened my mouth, twisting my twisted lips.

"Really."

I don't know if my story will be heard or not. Still, I didn't stop talking.

"Is this the story you want to see?"

Just like Kim Dokja that day who persuaded the constellations.

"No."

In the deep darkness of the theater, the readers still see Kim Dokja on the screen, not me.

They were watching 'Kim Dokja'.

But I felt they heard my voice.

【Wait. you.】

Representative Kim Dokja, who sensed something was going on, reached out to me and took my hand.

But it was already too late.

"As you all know, this world is a novel."

At that moment, I was grateful that this was a theater. I was grateful that readers gathered here.

I was grateful that I was Cheon Inho.

"A novel that you all know and I also know."

This is a complete fiction that everyone believes to be true.

And if this is fiction.

[The skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated!]

I had the confidence to tell that fiction better than anyone else.

"From now on, I will tell you the story you want."

When I closed my eyes, memories came to mind.

Memories I ignored.

「Cheon Inho.」

Stories beyond the wall that felt distant, like stories in a novel.

「How long has it been?」

「Very long.」

I collected the stories sentence by sentence.

「I will keep watching.」

It felt like warm snow was piling up every time the sentences touched me. The snow soon piled up on the ground, forming a snowy field.

I now know who Snowfield Kim Dokja was.

「But still, shouldn’t this story not have started?」

The person who read my story. The person who waited for this story to begin more than anyone else

"Well, it shouldn’t be like this."

Preparing a candy to give to Han Sooyoung.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Someone who already knew what I wanted to say.

「All the stories I know are stories you also know.」

「…」

「The person in front of me right now is not the real you, right?」

Those memories were there all along.

「Hakhyun-ah.」

Kim Dokja in my dreams.

My vague, distant, longed-for origin.

Just as <Kim Dokja's Company> collected fragments to find the one Kim Dokja, I also did the same for my past life that I had forgotten.

「No matter what, this time tell me a happy story.」

If I collect all these memories, will I become myself?

['Incite' exerts powerful power under special conditions.]

I do not know.

All I can do is lie.

A lie that will deceive me, deceive you, and ultimately deceive the world.

「If you believe that lie.」

I felt completely out of breath, and old sadness filled my mind.

Who am I?

Why did I come to this world?

I can now answer that question. My story was answering the question.

"I am 49% Kim Dokja."

My whole body trembled and sparks flew as if I had been electrocuted. Sparks soon flowed to the floor, and then spread like flames to the screen, following the countless footprints left by kkomas Kim Dokja.

The bright blue sparks spread white and colored the entire screen, stained white.

The screen looked like a dazzling snowfield.

One by one, the kkomas Kim Dokja who came to their senses began to look at me. Kim Dokja was reflected in those small eyes.

Kim Dokja was standing in the snowy field that day.

"So I."

49% Kim Dokja was saying this.

"I want to decide my own story."

There was silence, as if heavy snow had fallen. In that silence, Representative Kim Dokja smiled and opened his mouth.

【What on earth are you talking about? Now you think that anyone will believe you when you say such things—】

[rlaehrwk37 supports your story.]

As if taking my first steps on a pure white snowfield, someone looked at me. A very small but definite light. The light was shining towards me.

[rlaehrwk41 supports your story.]

Representative Kim Dokja immediately looked back at the decision.

【What now—】

Like the film in a projector running backwards, the scale of probability was changing.

The restraint of the theater that oppressed me weakened.

If I move my hands, the probability becomes weaker.

[rlaehrwk213 supports your story.]

As I tightened my legs, the possibilities became blurred.

[rlaehrwk99 supports your story.]

[rlaehrwk124 supports your story.]

[A temporary error occurred in the 'Beginning Theater'!]

I slowly turned around and looked at Representative Kim Dokja. Then the kkomas Kim Dokja also saw him and I called him by his real name.

"Asmodeus."

Sensing something was wrong, Asmodeus hardened his expression and lightly snapped his fingers.

[You broke the rules of the theater!]

[The props given to you have been recovered!]

The awakened Death Sword held in my hand disappeared.

But there was one more Death Sword for me.

Although it was not an awakened version of the item obtained as a reward after clearing the Star Labyrinth with the readers, it was nevertheless composed solely of the story of this worldline.

【No one is curious about your story. A crude story about you who has lost your memory and strength—】

In the main story, Kim Dokja borrowed the power of the Bukdu God Army to transform the Sain Tram Point.

But there was no constellation here to help me.

Perhaps no constellation will lend me their strength.

Just one thing,

「There is a constellation connected to me through 'story'.」

He was the constellation that all the stars ignored.

The man who laid down his authority and descended to earth, intending to play out the whole scenario once again.

A star who wanted to change his story more than anyone else.

[The story 'A Persistent Martial Arts Expert' begins its storytelling.]

The story he left behind is embedded in the sword body of 'Sainchamsagum'.

At best, it was a probability of a great person level constellation. A power that can only reveal one of the seven constellations of the Death Sword.

But that power was enough. This is because I now have the potential of readers.

Perhaps I can only use this sword once.

I decided to use that one opportunity here.

When I looked back, I saw a screen containing our story.

I swung my sword straight at the screen.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 675 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (11)

Sparks flew out and the screen was torn lengthwise.

[A fatal error has occurred in the Beginning Theater!]

Beyond the torn screen, the darkness of space shimmered pitch black.

A portal that leads to nowhere.

I looked back at the audience one last time. I saw rlaehrwk37 standing up and looking at me.

The Kim Dokja that was the first to support me.

Lee Dansu ahjussi’s daughter, Noh Jiyoon.

"I’ll definitely come back to get you."

Leaving behind Asmodeus' shout, I jumped into the torn screen with Yoo Joonghyuk.

[An error occurred temporarily in the 'scenario'!]

It felt like time and space were swirling and my body was disintegrating into cells.

Nevertheless, I did not let go of my grip on Yoo Joonghyuk.

I thought it was funny.

Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st round and 49% Kim Dokja. Is there another worst combination like this?

"Don’t die, you bastard."

Once again, my vision fluctuated and I felt like my body was being thrown somewhere.

The transfer was complete. I hit the floor, swallowing the pain that felt like every bone in my body was breaking.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

Yoo Joonghyuk still said nothing.

Is it because something happened to this guy and he still can't wake up?

"Haven’t you been passed out for too long?"

I managed to catch my breath and looked around. It was good that I escaped from the theater safely. But...

Why did I come to a place like this even though I was away?

A chill slowly seeped into my entire body. Even my breath seemed to freeze. No matter where I look, all I see is pitch black emptiness.

[The area is not a scenario area.]

A world where no stars shine on us. Through the darkness of the universe swallowed up by the distant void, I felt unknown gods looking down on us.

I lifted my head to look up at the sky, mocking our fate that cannot be recorded anywhere.

I saw it all.

[You have been kicked out of the scenario.]

It was like that.

We fell into the 'Great Hall'.

Someone was calling me in the darkness.

[Scenario departure penalty begins.]

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Han Sooyoung sighed in disgust and looked at her whole body. It was hard to breathe, as if her hand was full of hot water. Blood was constantly leaking from her punctured abdomen, and her left optic nerve was damaged, limiting her vision. Her right shoulder was completely shattered and unusable, and her kneecap was deeply wounded.

It was a wonder that her heart was still beating.

When was the last time she suffered such a serious injury?

She thought that was probably the case in the 1865th round.

When she was hunting the iron-blooded dragon with Yoo Joonghyuk and was waiting for Lee Seolhwa to arrive, exhausted.

「"It’s a little unfair."」

When she raised her head, it seemed like she could see the night sky that day. Lying side by side on the tail of the dead dragon, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke in his usual unlucky voice.

「"I should have said I would give the item to you."」

「"That’s not what I’m talking about."」

Han Sooyoung sighed lightly and added her words.

「"I was wondering who would know that we fought here like this."」

After saying that, Han Sooyoung regretted it. Because she was complaining, which was not like her. Han Sooyoung quickly shook her head and opened her mouth.

「"What's the use of telling you this-"」

「"Is that why you were writing a novel?"」

Han Sooyoung was surprised by Yoo Joonghyuk’s calm question.

She knows that she is secretly leaving her records everywhere except to Kim Dokja.

She never spoke.

But it seems like Yoo Joonghyuk already knew .

「"I can’t write everything down."」

The record of 1,865 rounds was incomplete.

She was losing her memories while using [Avatar] in real time, and her colleagues were not in a different situation.

In order to clear the scenario with minimal sacrifice, her companions fought with all their might, and in return, they each lost their stories.

Constant repetition of recording and disappearance.

「"There is no need to record everything."」

The words of a man who remembered more and forgot more than anyone else. Han Sooyoung spoke as if she was resisting.

「"Still, some very important things."」

「"When I repeat regression, I often forget my memories."」

These were the words of Yoo Joonghyuk, who rarely talks about himself. Han Sooyoung listened to him without even realizing it.

「"But memories from previous rounds are not always helpful."」

Han Sooyoung understood what that meant.

She must have many memories that she would like to forget, as she has repeatedly returned over the years.

Some memories would have tortured his emotions, while others would have interfered with his objective judgment.

「"I don’t remember anything. There were times when I found a better way."」

One day, Han Sooyoung may have decided to forget a disturbing memory. In order to clear the scenario, she did not even know how precious that memory was to her.

「"Don’t you want to regain your lost memories?"」

In response to Han Sooyoung’s question, Yoo Joonghyuk thought for a moment and then said.

「"Just because the memory has disappeared, it does not mean that the place where the memory was located has disappeared. And there is a guy who has a better memory than me."」

There was no need to ask who it was.

「"Weren’t you writing the story for him?"」

「"That's right."」

「"Do you think he’s going to blame you for not writing everything?"」

Han Sooyoung could not answer at that time. The answer that she couldn't give back then has now been given to Han Sooyoung.

"If it’s Kim Dokja."

Han Sooyoung thought about Kim Dokja.

Kim Dokja loves stories more than anyone else in the world.

If it were that guy, he would be focusing on the plot that she didn't write about in one way or another.

He will be able to reason between events and discuss the network of meaning on his own.

One day, he might argue with her.

Kim Dokja, who had been complaining for a long time, asking why she wrote it like this and wondering if it was plagiarism from the previous 'Ways of Survival', will finally read the story that she did not write.

He will finally fill in her own sentences, a story better than the words she had to write.

[The constellation 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight' says it would be better to stop coming in.]

[The constellation 'Sneaky Schemer' is worried about you.]

Han Sooyoung slowly raised her body.

She can't fight anymore with this body.

She knew instinctively, the damage was too serious. Not only was it impossible to proceed with a normal scenario, but complete recovery was also impossible without long-term treatment.

So, it was at this point that she left this world. Her foolish obsession is to quit and go back the way she came with her companions.

Finding a way to go back to the first portal prepared by Kim Dokja is also difficult.

It'll be fine.

Tsutsutsu-

A light spark flew as she put her hand in her pocket. When she took out her hand, she was holding a lemon candy that Kim Dokja had given her.

Han Sooyoung looked down at the candy, opened her wrapper, and put the candy in her mouth.

The moment she felt the sweet scent of lemon filling her mouth, Han Sooyoung suddenly understood why Kim Dokja had come to this world.

She understood why this world should exist.

「"There were times when I couldn’t remember something and found a better way in the next round."」

At the same time, she also realized why she had to come to this world.

Han Sooyoung looked up at the night sky.

Swirling Great Hall.

Her star didn't really look like they had disappeared somewhere, but she could imagine her own star.

She felt the star's gaze.

Han Sooyoung thought about the last sentence she would write.

---

How on earth can we return to the original scenario?

No matter how much I thought about it, I couldn't think of a way.

Probably the reason why Yoo Joonghyuk and I ended up here is because of Representative Kim Dokja.

It must be revenge.

The problem is that because of this, we could both end up dead.

A chill overtook my entire body. Cold sweat kept running down my spine.

My heart was pounding like it was going to explode.

Tsutsutsutsu-

A feeling of fear as if my existence would disappear at any moment. All I could do was close my lips and hold my breath.

[You are currently outside the scenario area.]

[Your body is currently in a very critical state.]

I knew very well what this was foreshadowing. It was like this when Kim Dokja was first thrown into the demon world.

—Damn! Butter for just 10, no, 15 minutes. Got it?

Is it a miracle?

Bihyung’s voice echoed distantly from somewhere.

—I'll connect the channel somehow and summon you again, so just wait...

But the voice quickly stopped and the cold came again.

I looked back at Yoo Joonghyuk in a spasm of consciousness.

I'm like this too, but what about Yoo Joonghyuk?

[The 'Tales of the Other World' protects this incarnation.]

Should I say it's a blessing among misfortunes?

Yoo Joonghyuk, who is about to ascend to the absolute throne, is temporarily connected to the 'Divine God of the Other World'.

It was in a state of being done.

In other words, the 'Divine God of the Other World, which was connected to him, was also bearing the penalty for leaving the scenario.

How many minutes passed like that?

[A temporary channel has been created.]

I heard a short message in my head.

Has Bihyung returned?

A picture of hope sprang to life in my head.

All I have to do is somehow receive a sub-scenario. If I only receive the scenario, I can prevent the collapse of my existence, just as Kim Dokja maintained the legend in the demon world.

[The constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are looking at you.]

...Asgard?

[The Nebula <Asgard> says they will provide you with a sub-scenario if you join as an incarnation under Asgard.]

I dreamed of sudden luck.

[If you accept this offer, you will not be able to refuse 'Asgard's' orders for the next 200 years.]

I opened my mouth in a daze, even forgetting to close it.

There wasn't even one suggestion.

[The constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> are looking at you.]

[The constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> will help if you become an incarnation of Olympus.]

[If you accept this offer, you will become the slave incarnation of the Nebula 'Olympus' for the next 50 years.]

I laughed out loud.

I felt like I finally understood Kim Dokja's anger towards the Nebulae.

"I refuse."

In my arrogance of having read all of this story, I had momentarily forgotten what the constellations were.

These were the constellations.

A tribe that exploits the lives of incarnations for their own pleasure, regardless of means or purpose.

[The constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are ashamed of your refusal.]

[The constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> sigh at your foolishness.]

Is it a penalty for rejecting the offer?

Suddenly, the chill that I felt throughout my body became even stronger.

I activated [Incite] while tightly hugging my trembling shoulders.

Somehow.

All I have to do is hold out until Bihyung returns.

"I am Kim Dokja…"

Is it because of the wildly bouncing sparks? [Incite] did not activate properly.

Instead, Kim Dokja's memories came to mind in the movements of my closed eyes.

「"Two years is longer than amortization."」

I couldn't tell when that memory was from.

Memories that do not exist in ORV.

Someone said in my memory.

「"In a little while, I will spend more time with you than with the Kim Dokja I know.」

I guess I'll lose."」

I looked around, gnawing away at that memory.

「"If the real 'me' returns, what happens to 'me' now?"」

In my memories, I was both happy and unhappy.

「"Just because another I exist does not mean that 'I' disappear."」

「"You can believe that there are 1,864 more of those bastards!"」

The reason I am happy is because it was Kim Dokja, and the reason I am unhappy is because it was Kim Dokja.

I muttered as I held my hand toward the blurry memories.

"I am..."

It was then that someone shook my shoulder.

Little by little, warmth spread throughout my body, and the cold that surrounded me gradually subsided. The memories that had swirled like a fierce snowstorm calmed down.

When I opened my eyes, someone was looking at me.

"Are you okay?"

I looked up at her blankly.

Is it a dream? I shook my head several times, but it wasn't a dream.

The story was being told through a small hand holding my shoulder. The warm and gentle sentences written by someone who loves this world were being conveyed to me in their entirety.

"Han Sooyoung."

Han Sooyoung looked at me blankly.

"You..."

Just as I read her story, she also read mine.

She muttered for a while and then opened her mouth.

"…Kim Dokja?"

I understood the faint anticipation and despair contained in that question. So my answer was decided.

"It’s been a while, Han Sooyoung."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 676 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (12)

Han Sooyoung looked at me. And she smiled and answered.

"You’re good at lying, you."

It doesn't work after all.

Well, there is no way that Han Sooyoung, who is not just anyone else, would not recognize 'Kim Dokja'.

Stories constantly flowed from Han Sooyoung’s fingertips, warming the surroundings. I felt as warm as when I was handed a cup of warm tea by Kim Dokja in the snowy field.

"How did you get here?"

There was only one way to get here from the scenario area on Earth.

"Have you crossed the Great Hall?"

Risking her life to cross the 'Great Hall'.

But why would she? For what reason?

Instead of answering, Han Sooyoung looked up at the sky.

Something like an opaque barrier appeared between the pitch-black sky. There were things shaking as if they were walls.

I immediately realized what they were.

A deity from another world.

These are also higher-level beings that I had never seen before.

It wasn't even just one.

A number so big that it covers the entire sky.

If just one of them lands in front of me, it will be fatal.

"Don’t worry. They can’t get over."

Han Sooyoung added without the slightest trace of fear.

"Even though this is an area on the outskirts of the scenario, those with a certain level of status will never be able to cross that 'Void Curtain'. And-"

The moment she finished speaking, I felt like something was trying to break through the curtain.

The moment a long tentacle pushed out the periphery of the curtain and popped out like a lump of water, a roar rang out from beyond the curtain.

A wave of magical power was seen crossing the opaque curtain.

A trajectory reminiscent of a meteor shower.

The gods of the other world that touched the trajectory were making loud noises and retreating or oxidizing.

"Because there is someone blocking it."

The infinitely deep trust felt in Han Sooyoung’s voice.

I know who is dealing with the gods of this world beyond the veil.

It was the same.

"You said your name was Lee Hakhyun."

I nodded and said.

"Did I make a full introduction?"

"Do you really have to tell me? You know my name too."

That's right.

We've never told each other our names.

Still, I knew hers.

We were telling each other's stories.

"Names are important. All stories are complete only when they are named."

[The story 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' resonates.]

The sentences she wrote and I wrote were chattering in the air.

「"A writer does not have complete control over his novel. When I suddenly look back, there are many holes here and there. In the end, reading is the work of connecting those irregular holes in one's own way."」

The sentences burned in the air and gave off a gentle energy. In this place without any scenarios, only the story was protecting us from the cold.

「"I don't know what you're talking about."」

「"…It means that over time, you can see what you wrote as if it were written by someone else. All humans are ultimately others to themselves."」

Han Sooyoung lit up her stories one by one, as if burning her matches, to provide warmth.

I couldn't ask if she was okay.

Of course she won't be okay.

I said something else.

"I had fun back then."

What did my answer mean?

Han Sooyoung's eyes briefly wavered.

"You remember?"

"How could I forget?"

In a way, that was my memory.

In my past life, I lived those times, and in this life, I wrote about those times, so I have lived them and lived them twice. And now, by reading them, I am living my third life.

I asked as I watched the story unfold in silence.

"Isn’t it a waste?"

Han Sooyoung pursed her lips and said.

"It’s okay now. You read it."

I nodded.

"Because Kim Dokja has a good memory."

"Huh."

We become readers once again, sentences that disappear in flames watched.

In those sentences, Kim Dokja was the king of a kingless world, the one who stood against miracles, the one who killed the king of disaster and the god of the other world, and the demon king of salvation.

"What salvation. Damn salvation."

I burst out laughing without realizing it. Han Sooyoung also smiled.

Regardless of our laughter, Kim Dokja’s story continued.

Liberate the industrial complex, confront the zodiac, confront the constellations of the Gourmet Association, visit the island of the reincarnated, liberate forgotten stories, and be acknowledged by the Last Dragon of the Apocalypse.

In it, Kim Dokja was called by various names.

Muttering the names that were on the tip of our tongues, we told the whole story together as if we were readers of the same person.

"Lee Hakhyun."

Suddenly, when she turned her head, a story burning like a fire was fluttering in her eyes.

「"Kim Dokja! You too, say something! When will I feel like this again?"」

I knew what she was going to say.

She said, "Can I call you 'Kim Dokja' one more time?"

I smiled bitterly.

I was going to say so.

Because lying is what I'm best at in the world.

However.

"Kim Dokja, I'm sorry."

I was suddenly speechless.

Why is this person apologizing to me?

For a moment, a feeling of dizziness struck my head. The box of memories that had been locked deep in the deep sea was opened, and scenes from the past came to mind one after another.

「"Kim Dokja, I'm sorry."」

In 49% of my memories, Han Sooyoung was speaking.

I was going to ask if this had been said before.

But Han Sooyoung was faster.

"I've wanted to tell you several times, but as you know, I'm not good at apologizing."

I looked at Han Sooyoung like that.

"In the 1865th round, it took the group two years to see the end of the scenarios."

During those two years, a lot happened to us while we were overcoming numerous scenarios.

「"What are you sorry about?"」

「"That is."」

「" About you trying to cut my head?"」

My former self said to Han Sooyoung, who lowered her head.

「"I don't mind. When did we stop trying to kill each other?"」

「"That was back then. Now—"」

「"If I were you, it would be the same. If Han Sooyoung had suddenly said that she actually plagiarized 'Ways of Survival', she would have been beheaded right away."」

「"Ah, if you still say that..."」

2 years is not short. We talked a lot during those two years. I have come close to death several times. We ate the dishes prepared by Yoo Joonghyuk together.

「"But I’m sure I almost killed you."」

In that world, 49% of Kim Dokja received what the original Kim Dokja should have received.

I went to the Han River and the sea with my group and ate chicken and pizza.

Although we did not live together in a very large house, we lived in that world together in a clear form. With them, I saw the completion of another world.

Han Sooyoung was speaking at the end of the world.

「"I will die for you at least once."」

The girl from the past who spoke as if she had multiple lives was now in front of my eyes.

"Sorry."

She was repeating the same apology again. As if she had never apologized before.

Why?

Didn’t the whole story end at the 1865th round?

「"I had an alter ego that I created when I first used [Avatar]... I guess I gave away too many memories, but it suddenly became out of control and I couldn’t retrieve it."」

It was only when I saw the story disintegrating into flames before my eyes that I suddenly realized it.

I see, she is.

「"I don’t know. But seeing as I'm fine now, it must have been a trivial memory."」

She has lost her memory.

「It’s because of Kim Dokja.」

Thus, she became a person who could never forgive herself.

I was trying to say something but was hesitant.

The me of today and the me of yesterday are different. Moreover, between 49% Kim Dokja and me, there was a much thicker wall of today and yesterday.

As time passed, Kim Dokja became me.

To what extent can the person I am now represent the person I was in my past life?

"I’m not asking you to forgive me, you know. That’s the kind of person I am."

If Han Sooyoung doesn't remember the story, wouldn't staying quiet do it for now?

"I’m sorry about that too."

We paused for a moment and looked at the burning waterway of the snowflake.

Suddenly everything seemed funny.

She has forgotten her own memories and I cannot fully remember my past life either.

We, who are strangely similar, are speaking on behalf of our past selves who no longer exist.

"You tried to kill me."

Can one human being truly forgive another human being?

"I did."

Can past mistakes be forgiven in the future?

Can Kim Dokja from a past life become Lee Hakhyun now?

"That."

Perhaps it was a very easy forgiveness.

Just as Yoo Joonghyuk, who tried to kill Kim Dokja, was forgiven. I could have moved on as if nothing had happened.

But I could tell.

That's not what Han Sooyoung wants now.

"I can’t forgive it, you know?"

Han Sooyoung smiled.

As if she was finally satisfied with never being forgiven.

「"Do you really think I’m an emotionless monster?"」

Han Sooyoung was seen running towards the Demon King of Salvation amidst the flames.

I was starting to get worried.

No matter how strong Han Sooyoung is, it would be dangerous if she lost stories anymore.

"Excuse me."

Cuckoo goo goo.

It was then that this happened in the sky.

Something was popping out near the void curtain that had been shaking earlier.

Han Sooyoung shook her head and reassured me.

"Don’t worry. Like I said before-"

There was a very faint sound of the curtain being torn, and something really came out.

Too small for a 'god from another world'.

I saw something resembling a human spreading black wings in the air.

"Han Sooyoung."

Han Sooyoung’s expression hardened.

"That’s—"

The humanoid god spread its wings in the sky and descended towards us.

Its form was small, but it didn't feel weak.

However, the ´Void Curtain' is a barrier that is affected by probability. Absolute beings of overwhelming status can never overcome that wall.

「What if there was an entity that could control its status enough to pass through the 'veil'?」

【Ooooooooo】

A cry that gives goosebumps.

I had no idea that I would even meet a god from another world in a situation where there was no scenario.

"I know what kind of guy he is."

Appearance of a human skeleton.

If you look closely, you can see the high neck and arms.

The backstory of various cultures was being shut down. Mold decorations that change every time the wings move.

Tsutsutsutsu!

A diamond shining brightly at the center of the crown on his head

Only then did I realize his identity.

"He is the one who created the absolute throne."

The reason why he came directly under the Void Veil was clear. It must be to find an 'agent' to inherit his throne. As it were,

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

It felt like the puzzles scattered around my head were coming together in an instant.

No way, the reason this person was so eager was.

"You."

Han Sooyoung stepped forward and said.

"You said you wanted to prevent the destruction of this world."

I could hear a strange heat in her voice. As I stood next to her, an unknown smile appeared on her lips.

"Even if Yoo Joonghyuk sits on the 'absolute throne', there is a way that this world will not be destroyed."

In the 41st round, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke through disaster Shin Yoosung.

If you use the 'Absolute Throne', you will never see the right ending.

This is because the 'Absolute Throne' is the passage that connects to the 'God of the Other World'.

Then,

"Is that possible?"

What would happen if we eliminated the reason why the 'absolute throne' is the 'absolute throne'?

"It’s possible if I help."

I slowly grasped the hilt of the sword as I watched the otherworldly god coming down from the air.

There are two authors here.

But there is only one sentence to write.

"Here we'll kill the 'founder of the absolute throne'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 677 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (13)

Two men stood in the pitch-black darkness. The corpses of the miserably severed tentacles were floating around them.

They were all otherworldly gods floating on the void veil.

Yoo Joonghyuk said after wiping away the black blood on the Black Heavenly Blade.

"You missed one guy."

A somewhat disapproving, scolding voice.

Then the man standing on the other side frowned.

"I guess I missed it."

The man wearing rags looked down at the empty curtain, calming the excitement flowing from his body.

The one who just ran away is now under that curtain.

"It’s hard to tear it open even with my stab."

The Void Veil.

The <Star Stream> was created to protect the scenario area from foreign interruption.

Only the Outer God who laid down his status by paying a great deal of probability is the only one who was able to go down.

The man looked down at the curtain and lightly pursed his lips.

"If you really want to destroy it, there's nothing I can't do."

"Then there will be hunting dogs targeting you."

"Do you think I'll be scared of hunting dogs?"

Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer.

Because the man in front of him was fully qualified to say those words.

There are probably not more than ten beings in the entire universe who can match him.

"Anyway, did you bring me here just to deal with these guys?"

"There are stronger gods. You know the <Star Stream> too much."

"I came along expecting to find a place to destroy. If it continues like this, I will leave first."

After the man muttered that, he closed his eyes with his arm as a pillow, as if he was annoyed.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the man for a moment and then found sparks that faintly gathered around them.

Tsutsutsutsu-

Outside the Void Veil, the influence of Probability is lowered.

Nevertheless, the signs of probability aftermaths showed that the <Star Stream> recognized them as a great threat.

'It will be difficult to descend on this world line for the time being.' Yoo Joonghyuk glared at the void curtain.

Although he couldn't clearly see beyond the opaque curtain, there were definitely two people he knew underneath it, and he could hear the sound of another god from another

world from the distance.

After grabbing the hilt of his sword, Yoo Joonghyuk muttered something quietly, not knowing to whom he was addressing it.

"Don’t die."

---

I don't know about other writers, but the first thing I consider before writing a story is one thing.

Is this a solvable case or an impossible case?

Most of them create incidents that can be solved somehow. Otherwise, long-term serialization will become difficult.

However, for any writer, there comes a moment when they have to take on an 'impossible event'.

【Ooooooooooo-】

For me, it was now.

Someone who makes my stomach tingle just by looking at him from afar.

There was no way I could face such a monster with a sober mind.

"You can do it. The main character grows up fighting things like that."

I nodded.

Perhaps Han Sooyoung has already faced numerous otherworldly gods. So, a guy like that-

"I’ll tell you in advance, I can’t be the main character."

Han Sooyoung's incarnation body was definitely a mess. Even at a glance, I could see that the bones all over her body were elaborately twisted or broken.

"Instead, I will lend you my story. Now, go and fight, protagonist."

I looked at her in bewilderment.

The 'God of Another World' currently descending from the sky was

a high-level entity I had never met before.

But you want me to fight that thing alone?

It was absurd.

"It is possible."

[The story 'Predictive Plagiarism' resides in your incarnation.]

The next moment, numerous Lee Hakhyun thoughts began to appear in my head.

「If the god of the other world came down from under the veil, it would mean that he sacrificed his 'status' to that extent.」

「There is a possibility that it is a clone and not the main body.」

「It might be the strongest enemy I've ever encountered, but that doesn't mean I can't deal with it.」

Han Sooyoung's story that flowed through my body gave me strength.

Now that I think about it, I forgot. The god of another world is strong, but Han Sooyoung is also strong.

Moreover, if it is an area outside of the scenario, as it is now, her original story will also exert a power that transcends probability.

Coo coo coo coo coo.

I applied my thoughts to my whole body as if testing a medium-sized story.

'Thoughts.'

The appearance of 'thought' changed with my command.

['Blade of Faith' is activated!]

I swung my sword at the 'founder of the absolute throne' who had approached me pointedly.

A strike that is dozens of times faster and more accurate than my usual attack. It felt like the Sword Master I had only heard about had possessed me.

Is that why?

Suga garak.

It was shallow. Although it was shallow, it definitely felt like something was being cut by the tip of the knife.

【Oooooh-】

The guy let out a loud cry. It felt deafening and nauseating. My entire body's hairs rose, and the goosebumps that ran down my spine did not stop.

The cause was obvious.

「The King's Tale.」

The story of a king who subjugates all living things was pouring out from his entire body.

My legs were shaking. The compulsion to kneel down immediately took hold of my mind.

This is the power of the founder of the Absolute Throne.

But I threw it away. I was able to endure it.

'I don’t know why.'

It may be because of Han Sooyoung’s story. It may be because the one who crossed the veil was considerably weakened, or it may be because I have already experienced hunting a god from another world once.

Either way, what is certain is that we need to make this situation 'solvable'.

【Dare】

When I did not kneel easily, a dazzling blade appeared in the founder's hand. At first glance, it was a dangerous relic that had the shape of a great sword.

"Watch out! It’s Excalibur!"

With Han Sooyoung’s warning. A storm of terrifying stories raged before my eyes.

Oh oh oh oh oh-

The souls that died under the sword screamed horribly. Normally, it was a terrifying blow that would have made me part of them too.

But now I am different.

[The story 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' continues.]

The stories we wrote were protecting us.

「"Kim Dokja! Damage!"」

I saw the trajectory of the attack that would normally be invisible.

Sugagak!

Having narrowly escaped the storm of stories, I held onto my sword and slashed horizontally.

"Keep going! Don’t give him any time to rest."

Sparks flew from its shins and a roar erupted. It worked.

"He is a god from another world, but his attribute is undead! Change the 'Blade of Faith' to the divine attribute!"

I did as she said without hesitation.

When the magic power that had been transformed into divine attribute mixed with the magic power of the butcher and created a sword storm, the god of the other world took a step back for the first time.

I can fight.

The magical power of my entire body was running wild as if it would explode, and my muscles were screaming like crazy. The story of Han Sooyoung, whose bones were throbbing with reaction, was not at a level I could handle.

[Your incarnation’s body is in critical condition!]

I grabbed the elixir in my pocket and swallowed it as much as I could to delay internal injuries.

We fought against each other.

Every time the swords clashed, my grip was torn and blood flowed. Every time a scar was left on his body, a long stab wound was left on my body as well.

It was the price of dealing with a god from another world in only the fourth scenario.

But I didn't think I couldn't win.

【Ooooooo-】

New bone joints sprouted from the angry founder's waist, forming two arms. Each arm held a sword that radiated an insidious energy.

Han Sooyoung shouted.

"Arondite and Gallatin! Do you know what they are?"

I knew it. In particular, Arondite is a famous sword that appeared in Yoo Joonghyuk's 1,863rd round.

These were all related to the story of King Arthur.

"Don't stop and fight! Looking at its performance, it might be a replica!"

The heavily secreted adrenaline and Han Sooyoung's [Predictive Plagiarism] made me forget the pain.

I predicted this guy's attack.

Arondite's sword slashed and cut off his left arm, and then he lifted Gallatin, who flew in with his waist, and I struck the guy's shin again.

Is it because of Han Sooyoung's story? It all felt so natural.

The indignant guy started spewing out harsh stories explosively. A half-moon-shaped force covered the entire area.

I took Han Sooyoung's story to the limit and exploded it at the end of the sword.

[The Fable 'Omniscient Reader' increases the appeal of the story.]

I hacked and hacked away at the creature's endlessly regenerating arm.

【Oh oh oh?】

That mighty god of another world was perplexed. Every time the sword flew through the air, Han Sooyoung's stories ran wild in my head.

[The story 'Predictive Plagiarism' speeds up its storytelling.]

An incredibly powerful and dynamic story. It's an incredible story that one individual built up.

I felt like I was a god.

The scenery seen by someone who completed a story was in front of me.

It was indescribably overwhelming, meaningless enough to be fleeting, and dizzying enough to make me vomit.

A future where sentences are written everywhere in the world.

A world where what happens next is determined by the trajectory of the sword I cut.

I was living in such a thorough web of stories.

I wanted to see what came next.

What is at the end of this road?

Ultimately, what will I face at the end of this story?

「"The story was good."」

I was intoxicated by that story and swung my sword again and again.

「"I just came here because I liked the story."」

It didn't matter anymore whether it was my sentence or Han Sooyoung's sentence. Even if I just transcribed her story.

It didn't matter.

If she helps this world line.

If we can fight together now, we might be able to put this terribly broken world back on track.

We may be able to reach the perfect ending to this world.

The moment I thought about it-

Tsutsutsu-

I quickly felt my strength drain away and quickly backed away from him.

Suddenly my stomach turned and I felt nauseous.

I spat out the story as if I was regurgitating what I had eaten. Something inside me was rejecting Han Sooyoung's story.

Someone was saying that Han Sooyoung's story was not mine.

「"Was there ever a time when Kim Dokja was happy to receive the heart he deserved?"」

Accompanied by dizziness, pitch-black darkness poured ceaselessly from my mouth.

「"What are you talking about? You're Kim Dokja too."」

「"Have you ever felt reassured even for a moment by those words?"」

I shook the memories away.

「"Like someone who intercepts and reads a letter sent by mistake, just a name like that."」

「"Didn't you enjoy a lot of things just because you had them?"」

I heard the sound of a wall shaking somewhere.

「"I guess I filled it all out of fear because I didn't want to share it with a real Christian."」

I held my head and shook my head.

Someone was talking.

There is no need to force a fight.

There's no need to face it.

It's been hard all this time.

I just receive warm comfort.

Living again under a different name in a new world.

"Hey! Wake up."

I saw the sword of Excalibur flying in front of me.

I cannot avoid it. There is nowhere to escape.

I'm in a place like this.

I fell to the floor with the feeling of something pushing me hard. A loud noise exploded in front of me.

A powerful storm of stories blew in.

The founder was seen being thrown away with a strong aftereffect.

When I took a deep breath and raised my head, Han Sooyoung was standing in front of me.

「That was the price she paid to change this world.」

When did the scenery change?

What is the reason that the number of story fragments floating around has decreased?

「"The story is told from the perspective of an omniscient reader."」

A huge hole opened in Han Sooyoung’s chest.

Through the hole, the white-burning sentences turned into ash and flowed down.

"Han Sooyoung!"

A gray snow field was created where the ash flowed.

Han Sooyoung stood above me and looked at me, wiping the blood from the corner of her mouth.

"Are you okay?"

Grabbing her left breast. She was laughing, blood pouring from her ears.

"From the “Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint that I wrote, colleagues do not die so easily."

Her whole body was shaking.

[The story 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' temporarily stops its storytelling.]

The heart that excitedly shouted that she would write my story disappeared somewhere, and an intense fear took hold of my head.

"I-"

I don't want to be left alone again.

Han Sooyoung, who had been coughing several times, fell forward.

As soon as I ran out to her, Han Sooyoung looked up at me and said,

"You know because you’re a writer too. Telling the story you want to say isn’t always a happy thing."

The color was draining from her face. I hurriedly covered her wounds, catching the pouring blood with my hands.

Han Sooyoung was looking up at the sky.

I must find an elixir. Whether it's a summoning corps, a demon corps, or anything.

「Han Sooyoung let go of her old home at that moment.」

It was only after I saw the sentences flowing out of her that it dawned on me that this was not just a trauma.

「The last sentence she will write is one she has never written before.」

The original story has been damaged.

"Wait, wait!"

I shouted as if denying that fact.

"This is an avatar, right?"

There is no way that 'Han Sooyoung', no one else, could die like this.

She is the smartest person in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

Isn’t she a writer who finds a way out in the face of any adversity?

But Han Sooyoung seemed not to be able to hear my voice, so she just looked up at the pitch-black sky.

As if there was something she was looking for there.

I followed her gaze and lifted my head. Someone was still fighting beyond the Void Veil.

The trajectory of a pouring meteor shower and the screaming gods of another world.

There were questions that came to mind only later.

How could Yoo Joonghyuk arrive beyond that curtain so timely?

Was it?

Where on earth did the probability to summon him come from?

Tsutsu-

The aftermath flowing through Han Sooyoung's body were breaking her, her body was disappearing. Her legs and torso were falling apart in the aftermath.

Han Sooyoung knew it from the beginning.

What she must do to change her established history.

「The margins of this world are limited.」

What do you have to sacrifice to push the button to fool the world line?

「Some sentences can only be written after erasing other sentences.」

Every time I hear a line story, Han Sooyoung also disappeared just like that one line. The sentences she wrote were falling apart in the air. The characters, events, and themes were scattered.

I shook Han Sooyoung’s shoulder.

Han Sooyoung's eyes, which were losing their light, turned towards me. Those eyes seemed to be looking at me, or they seemed to be looking into distant eternity.

It's like staring into a distant, beautiful snowy field where no sentences have been written yet.

I prayed.

She asked me.

"Why did you want to become a writer?"

I pursed my lips foolishly.

I thought I should give some kind of answer.

I wanted to find something to say to catch Han Sooyoung.

But no words came to mind. Even though I wrote so many sentences, not a single word came to mind.

Han Sooyoung’s hand brushed my cheek.

"I’m sorry I couldn’t tell you the story you wanted."

That was the last time.

I opened my mouth.

"I, I-"

「Han Sooyoung disappeared.」

It would be an avatar. The avatar disappeared.

There is no way Han Sooyoung could die.

Han Sooyoung-

[The story 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' ends its storytelling.]

And one by one, the stories that were being told in my ears stopped talking. The endless chatter and unstoppable conversation came to an end.

[The story 'Predictive Plagiarism' concludes its storytelling.]

After the whole story was over, I was left alone again.

Han Sooyoung's 'Unbreakable Faith' was seen as it fell to the floor.

「Why did you want to become a writer?」

Only after every sentence was erased, after I lost every story I loved, did I finally find the answer.

"I want to know who I am."

I heard the walls inside me collapsing.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 678 Episode 21 Kim Dokja (14)

---

As the wall collapsed, memories came flooding in from beyond.

Memories that I didn't believe were mine.

Sentences that were as distant as the author and the characters seeped into my skin, blood vessels, and brain.

I could see the founder of the Absolute Throne coming towards me in the distance. Although he lost one wing, he survived the explosion.

He was not dead, but was walking to destroy this world.

「So who am I.」

In the creeping cold, I thought about my arrogance. The arrogance that tried to contemplate this story, that dared to write about this world.

"Han Sooyoung."

Han Sooyoung’s miracle could not be felt anywhere. I didn't feel her story.

「"Why did you want to become a writer?"」

Holding Han Sooyoung's sword, I stood up slowly. Now there was no more Han Sooyoung's story that protected me. 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' stopped its storytelling and 'Predicted Plagiarism' failed to predict the future.

It came running high and far away, and I also ran towards it.

We cut each other's flesh with each other's swords. I thought about the living pain of the blade cutting into my body.

「You can't just be a writer.」

To see the ending of this story, you shouldn't be in such a presumptuous position.

「I have to live in this world properly.」

We have to face it.

We must live in this clear world that exists through blood and swords.

It has to be a unique character.

A person who knows this story better than anyone else. The only person who has the potential to clear this scenario.

The founder of the Absolute Throne asked amidst a storm of magical power.

【Who are you Who are you】

"I am Kim Dokja."

It was not [Incite].

The guy tilted his head. It seemed like he didn't know who Kim Dokja was.

"I am."

So I did it one more time.

"Kim Dokja."

I said that cursed name.

[The story 'Recorder of Things that will Disappear' begins its storytelling.]

A story that was about to disappear stayed with me.

As I felt the narrative gripping a pen, I recalled the moment I first entered this world.

I thought of a story I wanted to write. I wanted to write about extras, about things that are forgotten, about things that go unnoticed.

I had to admit it now.

Actually it was all a lie.

I just wanted to tell my story.

[The story 'Recorder of Things that will Disappear' sucks up the scattered fragments of the story.]

The sentences floating around radiated bright light and seeped into me. The fragments were randomly mixed together, telling me between the lines.

「"Don’t run away, Kim Dokja."」

I didn't want to admit it. I wanted to run away. So I set up a lie.

I am a writer. This is someone who can look at this story objectively.

With those words, I ran away from my past life.

I didn't want to become Kim Dokja, so I was reincarnated as myself.

However, the reason why I did not want to become Kim Dokja in my past life was because I wanted to become Kim Dokja more than anyone else.

Because I thought I couldn’t become Kim Dokja.

I gathered all my courage and ran to the god of the other world.

The brightly shining 'Unbreakable Faith' exuded the strength of a butcher.

Almost at the same time, the guy's Excalibur also spewed fire.

At the same time as the sharp blade pierced my skin, the sword I swung also cut into its torso.

【Ooooooo-】

Through the pitch-black dust, I could see him staggering back a dozen steps.

At first glance, it was a fatal wound.

Its arm no longer regenerates and its only weapon is Excalibur. At least it felt like it was difficult to hold the Excalibur.

I stumbled closer.

All I have to do is deliver the final blow. With just one final blow, I can begin to change this world.

Tsutsutsutsu-

For a moment, my vision flickered.

When I opened my eyes, my eye level had changed. I realized I was on my knees. The 'Unbreakable faith' that had lost its shine was rolling around on the floor.

A bright blue light was shining in the eyes of the founder, who was glaring at us from afar.

It was a king's tale.

Tsutsutsutsutsu-

I had no strength to resist anymore.

The founder, who was watching my movements from 20 steps away, slowly did it as a test.

He took a step.

Now nineteen steps.

[The temporary channel will be restored!]

Just then, the channel opened.

It was Bihyung.

—It's out, you bastard! Damn, what is this again! No, what the hell…

Sixteen steps.

—Hey! I'll summon you right now-

"Don’t do it."

—What?

I took a deep breath, and grabbed the sword that was lying on the floor.

"I’m not going back."

At least I can't go back until I kill that guy.

I corrected myself and looked down at the floor covered in pure white snowflake ash.

I couldn't feel her story anywhere else in the world. Nevertheless.

「Alive.」

I wanted to believe that. She must be alive and not dead somewhere. I couldn't bear to not believe that.

「Han Sooyoung is alive here.」

Between all the lines she wrote and then erased, she remained. I said, sweeping between the lines with my palm.

"Bihyung."

I sent a short message through 'Dokkaebi Communication'. After hearing my story, Bihyung opened his mouth.

—I can't help it. It's a violation of the contract, but I'll just ignore it once. As of now, there is no big solution.

Bihyung accepted my offer.

—Instead, I will charge you twice the commission from now on.

Next, a scenario came down from thin air.

[A new sub-scenario has arrived.]

Warmth began to return to the place where the story blossomed.

[The 'scenario area departure penalty' is lifted.]

The cold went away and I returned to the scenario.

**<Sub Scenario - Founder of the Absolute Throne>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty : ???

Clear conditions: Kill the founder of the Absolute Throne

Time limit: —

Compensation : ???

Failure: —

The moment I read the scenario, I realized how ridiculous the fight I had been in was.

A nonsensical enemy that was not listed on the level of difficulty was pushed to the brink of death.

He was now eleven steps ahead.

Right now, I don't have any magic left.

Since he knows that fact, he must be secretly approaching me.

But there was one last way left for me.

Now that the channel has opened, the stars will be watching me.

"I will sign a sponsor contract."

The stars in the night sky did not respond to my declaration.

The reason was quickly apparent.

[The Nebula <Asgard> laughs at your judgment.]

Asgard, who had a grudge because of the previous incident, interfered.

[The Nebula <Olympus> declares that if it makes a behind-the-scenes contract with the incarnation Cheon Inho, it will be hostile to some constellations.]

I smiled into the air.

Right.

Is that your choice?

Before I knew it, the god of the other world had taken nine steps forward and called my name.

【Kim Dokja.】

「The name is important. All stories are complete only when they are named.」

Everything in this world is made up of stories, and every story is complete only when it is given a name.

Coordinates that designate only one constellation in that vast universe. The only language that can gather the scattered light in the pitch-black night sky.

「At least in this world, there is only one star that can guide me.」

A constellation that will not contain the stories I will build and will not force me into unfair contracts.

He had many names.

Eight steps.

The first one was so loud and distant that I couldn't tell exactly what it was called.

The founder's steps began to speed up.

The second name was not something I could fully accept yet.

Seven steps.

He did not exist where the third name was.

Six steps.

And there is only one last name left that I can call.

Five steps.

The moment I entered the attack radius, the founder swung Excalibur at me.

He decided that I no longer had the strength to fight back.

I opened my mouth.

[Sub-skill 'Sentence Strengthening' is activated!]

[You can enter your actions.]

[The actions you enter will be reinforced.]

[You can increase the reinforcement level by investing stocked probability.]

[Current probability: 580]

Using all the probability I have.

「"I will make a contract."」

He will definitely read these words.

I swung my sword with all my remaining strength.

Wow!

'Unbreakable Faith' collided with Excalibur and flew through the air.

The moment the god of another world twisted his trajectory to aim for my waist, I jumped up and swung the sword I had taken out of my back bag.

Just in time, my sword cut into his side first.

The founder looked surprised, as if he thought I had almost no energy left. His guess was true.

But he won't know. From now on, what will happen before his eyes?

【Oooooh-】

The guy must have sensed something strange and walked back, gesturing at his skull.

I got sick.

I will take a step forward and take a breath. The story of the ark, overflowing from my entire body, were gathering in my blade.

「That's my favorite story.」

Without hesitation, I swung my sword at the screaming guy.

The shank was trained much more neatly than the [Baekcheonganggi] I use, and it was very good on the guy's upper abdomen.

【Gooooooooo-】

The confused guy was trying to communicate with the other side of the veil through a link in the air.

But I had no intention of allowing that.

"Death Sword."

As I said those words, the constellations engraved on the body of the Death Sword sword began to glow one by one.

Originally, to reveal all the constellations of the 'Death Sword', seven great-level constellations were needed.

But now, it was limited to just one constellation.

The startled outer god screamed and trembled.

He is a great god of another world.

This guy wasn't afraid of the relics of the great constellations.

He recognized the story behind this sword.

[The story 'King of a Kingless World' begins its storytelling.]

I cut the sword stuck in the guy's chest and split off his head.

Its body split in half and scattered with a scream.

The link was broken.

Sparks emitted in the air, and eventually the wick touched and burned like a candle with only a few moments remaining.

[Sub-scenario cleared!]

[The fourth main scenario has ended.]

[You have achieved an achievement that does not exist]

[A significant number of constellations have entered the temporary channel.]

Stars were rising one by one above the pitch black curtain.

The constellations took risks and came to the 'Great Hall' to see me.

[The 'Administrative Bureau' praises your achievements.]

[The 'Management Bureau' is preparing a reward appropriate for your achievements]

[A new story has been acquired.]

Stars appeared in the night sky when the king disappeared. Looking up at the stars, I thought of a man who had seen the same scene as me a long time ago.

「The story is still Kim Dokja's story.」

A name I hated, hated, and loved.

「But it's still not a story for just one Kim Dokja.」

[A constellation that did not reveal their modifier reveals their modifier.]

[The constellation contract has been completed.]

I looked up at our star while carrying the fallen 41st Yoo Joonghyuk on my back. There were so many stars that I thought I wouldn't be able to find it

The star that Yoo Joonghyuk so desperately wanted to find, and the star that Han Sooyoung so desperately wanted to meet.

[Your sponsor is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 679 Episode 22 Name (1)

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「One day, an incarnation asked their sponsor.

"You are one, so why are there multiple nicknames for you?"

Then the sponsor answered.

"Why do you think I am one?"」

---

She began writing her first novel when she was about thirteen.

It's like that for everyone, but the beginning was usually similar.

She happened to write, win awards, and get compliments from people saying she was good at writing.

"Sooyoung. What happens next?"

She found it fascinating that someone was curious about the story she wrote.

"Are you curious?"

A universe the size of a notebook. In the small world created by her, she was a god.

Her characters live or die depending on the sentences she writes. Friends who read her story also laughed with her.

The problem is that it is difficult to have class time.

"Sooyoung."

The homeroom teacher called her during recess.

Although she was young, Han Sooyoung, who was quick to notice, realized how her work was going, so she bowed her head first.

"Sorry."

Her homeroom teacher nodded at her as if he was impressed by her, then handed her back her notebook and said,

"Be careful during class."

He then scratched her chin for a moment as if he wanted to say something.

Looking back now, the young teacher may be conscious of a certain congressman, Han Sooyoung's father.

"It’s not just your fault. It’s also the kids’ fault for reading in class."

Anyway, the young teacher proudly picked up a passage from a book she was reading and said,

"There is a saying that a work becomes the reader’s the moment it leaves the author’s hands."

That obvious and cliché sentence sounded a little strange to thirteen-year-old Han Sooyoung.

"Why?"

"Huh?"

"I wrote that, so why does it belong to the reader?"

The teacher laughed at the bold and childish question.

Was it because he wanted to leave his influence on a child who might one day become a writer?

The young teacher added a word without expecting the child to understand.

"Some writings are only completed when the writer dies."

Some writings are only completed when the author dies.

Young Han Sooyoung pondered those words several times and then asked back.

"Then what is left for the writer who has completed the work?"

"Well, you can make money and gain fame."

"Is that all?"

The young teacher felt embarrassed by young Han Sooyoung's disappointed expression, and concentrated on finding a better answer.

But he couldn't find the answer.

It was natural. After all, the words he picked up weren't his sentences either.

So the teacher quickly ended the conversation.

“Well, if Sooyoung finds out someday, will you let the teacher know?"

The following year, the teacher was transferred, and Han Sooyoung was never able to see him again. Although it was not necessary to give the teacher the answer, Han Sooyoung continued to write after that.

As it turned out, she was lucky, and her writing became known to the world early on.

Many loved reading her novels.

She wrote like she was truly a character living in that world.

When she came to her senses, Han Sooyoung was also in that world.

「What remains for the author who has completed their work?」

Living in that world with her colleagues, laughing, crying, and overcoming the danger of death.

Han Sooyoung felt like she was getting closer to the answer little by little.

Maybe she met someone who seemed to know the answer.

In order to get that person back, Han Sooyoung sat in front of the keyboard again.

But she didn't know what to write. She didn't know what should be done in this blank space. It's as if she went back to her childhood when she first picked up a pen. What and how should she write to get that guy back?

As she was contemplating for a while with her head in her hands, someone who came to visit was in front of her.

"If you want to save Kim Dokja, you have to die."

He was the Dokkaebi King of the 1863rd round.

---

The Dokkaebi King came right after Han Sooyoung, Yoo Joonghyuk, and several colleagues from <Kim Dokja's Company> reached the end of the story.

The end of『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

The colleagues who opened the door to the hospital room where Kim Dokja was hospitalized faced two endings.

One is the ending where Kim Dokja returns.

The other is the ending in which Kim Dokja does not return.

Han Sooyoung and her colleagues, who wanted to bring back all of Kim Dokja, said, 'If Kim Dokja does not come back, I can't accept the possibility that there could be a bad ending.'

However, they didn't know what to do to get Kim Dokja back in the world after the ending.

"It's so pathetic. You too."

The Dokkaebi King muttered as he drank Americano through a straw. Han Sooyoung made a protest.

"Who are you here to tease?"

A colorless landscape that seems to be made of plaster. Sitting in a cafe made of spiritual structures. The two people drank coffee and iced chocolate, respectively.

"Damn, it tastes like boiled newspaper."

"It’s a world that no one has ever written about. The taste has never been properly described."

The Dokkaebi King looked around with leisurely eyes.

He wasn't just at the cafe. No matter where he looked, this world was not normal.

A world filled with sparse blank space, like scribbles on a childhood notebook.

"It seems like you had a hard time imagining this world."

"Of course I believed that Kim Dokja would come back."

While saying those words, Han Sooyoung looked at the Dokkaebi King’s attire.

A white coat and a deep felt hat.

There was no mistake. This 'Dokkaebi King' was the same 'Dokkaebi King' who was with Han Sooyoung in the 1863rd round.

"Why are you dressed like Kim Dokja?"

"It’s because it’s popular to dress like this in the world line I recently traveled to."

"I thought you were still on the subway."

"The main body is there. But sometimes I also want to go outside."

"What kind of Dokkaebi are you? Come to think of it, the way you speak is different from back then."

The Dokkaebi King lightly cleared his throat and opened his eyes with cool eyes.

【Shall I say it this way, Han Sooyoung?】

Han Sooyoung threw the straw on the floor, took a shot of iced chocolate, and slammed it down on the table.

"Hey."

"Yes."

"Where is Kim Dokja?"

The Dokkaebi King muttered as if he was in trouble.

"A similar thing happened before."

Han Sooyoung also remembered it.

There was no way she could forget it.

Memories of the 1865th round.

They attempted a 'Group Regression' using Yoo Joonghyuk's power to retrieve the lost Kim Dokja.

"Are you going to repeat that mistake again?"

Then they failed once.

The person who announced its failure was the Dokkaebi King right in front of her.

The Dokkaebi King who protected Kim Dokja who became 'the Oldest Dream'. A being who assisted the young god for a long time and transformed into the [Fourth Wall].

"Do you think we had any other choice?"

Han Sooyoung said, suppressing her anger.

"Kim Dokja, who was left behind in our world line, was dying."

In a world where the system disappeared, 49% of Kim Dokja created with [Avatar] lost his power and was dying.

In order to save either side of Kim Dokja, the party had no choice but to cross world lines.

"Kim Dokja didn’t want you to come. It was his happiness to watch your stories."

"Did my reader say that with his own mouth?"

"..."

"Look. You don’t even know."

"You speak like you know."

"I don’t know. So I’ll ask when we meet."

"Do you really believe you can meet him again? Why don’t you give up?"

Han Sooyoung searched through her pocket and took out a lemon candy.

"He risked his life to save us."

"Isn’t that common in the world of the Star Stream?"

"He really died for us, time and time again."

Han Sooyoung still remembered all of Kim Dokja's deaths.

She never forgot a single moment.

The same will be true not only for her but for everyone in <Kim Dokja’s Company>.

"I know that Kim Dokja comes back to life when he dies, but how many people do you think would actually risk their lives for others just because they have the power of resurrection?"

"How many people do you think will repeat such crazy things over and over again throughout their lives?"

Are resurrected humans really the same as humans before they died?

Isn't a human being, in which all the cells that make up the body have been analyzed and reloaded, simply a duplicated being, like a text that has been repeatedly copied and pasted?

No one knows the right answer.

It was probably the same for Kim Dokja. Nevertheless, he was willing to die for his companions. Then he came back to life.

"I was saved by a guy like that. I saw him die before my eyes several times. I clearly remember the pain, the suffering, the smiling face until the last moment with my own eyes."

"..."

"He suffered something like that. Do you think it’s possible to think that enough is enough?"

The Dokkaebi King looked at Han Sooyoung for a long time and then quietly sighed.

"Everything is already written down and is being written down at the same time."

"Are you going to help me?"

The Dokkaebi King paused at Han Sooyoung’s soft voice.

The Dokkaebi King is one of the few beings who can move to another world line at will.

If he helps, they may be able to trace the missing traces of Kim Dokja.

Unexpectedly, the Dokkaebi King obediently nodded his head.

"As I said before, if you want to save Kim Dokja, you have to die."

Han Sooyoung frowned and asked back.

"You said that a little while ago. What are you talking about?"

Han Sooyoung thought for a moment and added.

"Is my death also written on your 'wall'?"

"The memory of meeting me now will be erased from the wall."

"Because it goes against probability."

"Yes."

"Don’t worry. I won’t die. So feel free and help me."

The Dokkaebi King looked at her with sad eyes and then looked up at the empty space.

"Your story will soon be over."

Snow was falling from the sky.

Pure white snow that covers everything, living and dead, written and unwritten.

"What's left for you now, Han Sooyoung?"

What is left for her? Han Sooyoung opened her mouth, taking in a breath of cold air.

She was going to answer.

But her voice didn't come out.

Time froze as well, with the snow touching her cheek.

When she blinked, the Dokkaebi King had disappeared. The Dokkaebi King was not the only one.

The surrounding scenery, her arms, legs, torso, and organs that could speak had already disappeared.

Ah.

Memories came flooding back later.

Memories of finding the 41st round using the equipment left behind by the Dokkaebi King.

There, she remembered meeting Lee Hakhyun, the reincarnation of 49% Kim Dokja.

Memories of damage to the incarnation while fighting Asmodeus.

Memories of joining forces with Lee Hakhyun to defeat the Outer God.

Finally, the memory of her incarnation disappearing.

Was it a flash of light?

A distant cold hugged her in the darkness.

Her soul was slowly disappearing from the edges. She could feel the end of her life steadily approaching. She knew it without anyone telling her.

This death has already been recorded.

It cannot be avoided with [Avatar] or anything else.

In her darkness, she felt the story she had written leaving her.

Han Sooyoung recalled a sentence she once wrote with her own hand.

「The moment the world is completed. The writer must step down from the position of creator.」

That is the fate of all works.

「For readers to be born, the writer must die.」

Han Sooyoung now understood the Dokkaebi King’s words. She laughed while feeling the flesh of a god into the pitch-black darkness of the universe.

Somewhere in this universe, there is a being reading this story with her, obviously.

So, if this can be a 'probability' for him to survive.

Soon, darkness, like dense print, swept in, and Han Sooyoung's soul disappeared into the abyss.

---

And in the pitch-black darkness, a man, who had once been the protagonist of this story, realized that she was dead.

"Han Sooyoung?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down under the void curtain and muttered.

It was strange.

He definitely felt Han Sooyoung's story a little while ago, but suddenly he couldn't feel anything.

It was as if the entire story about her had been erased from this world.

What that meant was obvious, but Yoo Joonghyuk could not admit it.

As much as Han Sooyoung knew Yoo Joonghyuk, he also knew Han Sooyoung well.

There is no way Han Sooyoung could die like this.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk's colleague, who does not know Han Sooyoung well, did not think so.

"It’s time to go back."

The man who was repeatedly stabbing and defeating the abyss hounds said.

"It doesn’t matter to me, but if we keep fighting here, the entire area will be caught up in it. For their safety and also for the safety of the 41st round, we have to leave quickly."

Yoo Joonghyuk also thought so.

That was until a small beam of light passed under the void veil.

"Hey."

Meteors that fell down from far away in space passed them by and created a void curtain.

"Yoo Jong-"

Before the man could finish speaking, Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation, moving like a flash, collided with the void curtain.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who let the meteorite go as is, did not allow it. The moment he touched the curtain, a terrible electric shock struck Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body.

Even as his flesh burned black, Yoo Joonghyuk stretched out his hand toward the veil.

As if there was something beneath that veil that he had been searching for all along.

"Are you crazy?"

In the end, the man stepped forward and pulled up Yoo Joonghyuk.

Even as he was grabbed and dragged by his man, Yoo Joonghyuk did not look away from the veil.

"There was…"

"What?"

He saw it, even though it was only for a moment.

A faint ray of light that appeared as soon as Han Sooyoung's story disappeared and appeared for a moment before disappearing.

He doesn’t know why that light twinkled there.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk recognized the light.

Because that light was the light of the star that protected him for a very long time.

"Kim Dokja."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 680 Episode 22 Name (2)

Hello everyone.

This is Lee Hakhyun.

In the meantime, things have escalated.

You've probably all forgotten my name. Of course. It's not a very cool name.

If you're the main character, I guess you would be named Yoo Joonghyuk.

Shouldn’t it be a name like that? Suddenly, it’s Lee Hakhyun.

In other words, it feels like a person from the real world has suddenly possessed someone in a web novel.

But as you all know, I am truly possessing a character in a web novel.

I wasn't even just possessing someone, it was a shabby villain—

—Cheon Inho.

You're right. That name.

Cheon Inho.

This is the name of the villain I possessed.

—I haven’t woken up for quite some time.

—They said it was a miracle that I was alive.

I don't know who you are, but you are telling me what I want to say.

That's my life after possessing Cheon Inho.

Being alive is a miracle.

Even at Geumho Station.

Even in Chungmuro.

Even in the theater dungeon.

Even at Seoul Station and Gwanghwamun.

I really almost died.

I don't know what's going on these days, perhaps because I've been at risk of dying so many times that I've lost my mind.

In particular, I don't know who I am.

It sounds like something a second year middle schooler would worry about, but I'm serious.

Is it because I used [Incite] too much? Or is it because I didn't think enough about my own identity in my second year of middle school?

Either that or—

【How long are you going to talk like that?】

Oh, that's right.

You can't take such a half-hearted attitude anymore.

Please forget all the self-introductions I’ve made so far.

We'll do it right again.

Hello everyone.

My name is Kim Dokja.

It's really awkward to say this, but I'm serious.

I am the reincarnation of 49% Kim Dokja.

By the way, everyone.

I'm a little scared.

Everyone, think about it too.

One day, I suddenly possessed a character in a novel, and it became 'the reincarnation of the main character in my novel turns out to be me'.

Does such a light novel-like development make sense?

If Ji Eunyu, the editor in charge, heard about it, she would make fun of it forever.

Ji Eunyu would definitely say this.

"Wow, author-nim! Readers made fun of Kim Dokja, saying he was the author's own character, but it wasn't his character, it was him. Wow, wow."

Ji Eunyu.

I feel really unfair.

First, let me make one thing clear: I didn't actually write that novel.

The writer who wrote that story is Han Sooyoung...

Han Sooyoung?

...

I jumped up from my seat with a hysterical scream.

My heart was pounding like crazy and my breath was pouring out all the way to my chin.

Someone's shadow glimmered through my hazy vision.

"Inho-ssi?"

Sensation slowly returned from my fingertips. The feel of the soft bed and blanket. A hospital-specific disinfectant smell.

My mind was confused.

What happened?

What about Han Sooyoung?

What about the Outer God?

What about Yoo Joonghyuk?

Did we succeed?

When I opened my eyes with difficulty and looked ahead, I saw the shape of a familiar person.

Kind eyes shining beneath the devoted eyebrows.

"Inho-ssi!"

Lee Dansu who no longer called me a friend hugged me tightly.

Why? The moment I was hugged helplessly by Lee Dansu, without realizing it, my body lost strength and tears poured out.

"Thank goodness. I'm so glad."

There were so many tears that it was surprising that even a villain had so many tears stored up.

As I listened to the man repeatedly saying that it was fortunate, I thought again that this was a fortunate thing.

"Ahjussi."

That's how I survived again.

This time, I sacrificed someone on my behalf.

There were people who were the first to run when they heard my news.

These were people I knew well.

It feels like it's been a while, so I'd like to briefly introduce them.

"Aaaah! Inho-ssi!"

The name of the girl running towards me over there is Kyung Sein.

Although she appears to be a woman on the outside, she is actually a reader with the soul of a man.

"You're awake, Kim Dokja."

The man in the black coat standing proudly in the doorway of the hospital room is the second apostle, 'Killer King'.

Even though he looks like that on the outside, he is a crazy person who has read 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' over a hundred times.

He has a habit of constantly calling me 'Kim Dokja', but I don't know if he does it knowingly or not.

For reference, he has a younger sister who uses the ID 'Literature Girl 64'. Yerin is a very normal person, unlike her older brother, Killer King.

"Inho-ssi, how do you feel right now? Do you see these fingers and a dog? Can you tell me your name? How old are you? What is your real name in real life?"

The name of the boy who took advantage of my confused state of mind to get information from me is 'Ye Hyunwoo'.

This boy, who looks just like today's gifted child from a gifted education program, is the commander of the Chungmuro Group and the brain that leads the readers.

"Yes. I'm fine."

"You still have a bit of a fever, so I think it would be better to rest more."

Lastly, the name of this handsome man who took my temperature is 'Lee Dansu'.

He is the first reader I have ever met, and he is a man living in this world trying to get his daughter back.

The rest of the party... hasn't arrived yet.

I tried to name them one by one in my head.

Jung Heewon, Cha Yerin, Ji Eunyu, Koo Seonah...

"Inho-ssi."

Amidst a light silence. It was Lee Dansu who opened his mouth again.

Why? The eyes of people looking at me were different.

It seemed like he was trying to figure out what to ask, or he seemed to be having trouble deciding what to say.

I smiled lightly and opened my mouth first.

"Can I ask what happened so far?"

---

"I was unconscious for 45 days?"

While listening to Kyung Sein's fussing voice, I could think in my head how long 45 days.

No, wait a minute.

So what scenario is this now?

"The seventh scenario is currently underway on the Korean Peninsula."

I couldn't believe my ears.

"Not the fifth?"

"Hey, when did the fifth scenario end?"

The last scenario I remember was the fourth scenario, 'the King’s Qualifications'.

"Wait a minute."

I rested my head for a moment and thought about the development of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

The fifth scenario in the original Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint was 'Disaster of Floods'.

'Disaster of Floods' is a scenario that ends only after defeating as many as four disasters, even excluding the main Disaster of Floods.

Even if I killed one at the National Palace Museum, have they already killed the remaining four?

"The fifth scenario was solved by Yoo Jung-hyuk himself. And the main character was the main character."

"How did he clear it? Could it be that he killed Shin Yoosung—?"

"Have you forgotten that this is the 41st round?"

A vivid feeling rose up.

Right.

This is the 41st round of 'Ways of Survival'.

That was also the world line before 'Shin Yoosung' returned to the second round to become the 'Disaster of Floods'.

In other words, there is no 'Disaster of Floods' yet in this round.

But the disaster was not only the Disaster of Floods.

"The Disaster of questions was quite formidable. However, I easily defeated it with the help of this body."

"The 2nd Apostle was not active, and Yoo Joonghyuk killed him."

I roughly understand the situation.

I don't know what kind of disaster occurred, but in any case, it seems that Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round suppressed it with terrifying force.

"Speaking of the fifth... What happened to the sixth scenario? That must have been tricky too."

The sixth scenario is 'Peace Land' with Japanese incarnations.

In some ways, it was a scenario that could be more difficult than the 'Disaster of Floods'.

"Yoo Joonghyuk went and finished it himself."

“Yoo Joonghyuk?”

I asked in a doubtful voice.

Not like any other scenario, 'Peace Land' is a scenario where Disasters and Inhabitants take sides and fight.

"Could it be that Yoo Joonghyuk became a disaster?"

I asked, assuming the worst outcome first.

If in the 41st round, 'Yoo Joonghyuk' had chosen the side of disasters, 'Peace Land' would have been—

"Don’t worry. Yoo Joonghyuk took the inhabitants’ side."

Yoo Joonghyuk? really?

"We arrived faster than expected and the damage was greatly reduced. We cooperated well with the Japanese incarnations. Asuka Ren and Izumi are both safe! Isn’t that surprising?"

Asuka Ren and Izumi, the king of Japan, are safe..

If you just listen to the story, the situation wasn't that bad.

"What about Kyrgios?"

"I didn’t meet Kyrgios. I guess the events in this round were divided."

After all, if one thing goes well, the other thing goes wrong.

My original plan was to meet Kyrgios Roadgrim in Peace Land and train to become a Transcendant.

But I was passed out, and Kyrgios didn't even visit 'Peace Land'.

"The seventh scenario is still in progress. Actually, Yerin and Heewon are in the scenario area because of that. Oh, and Jiwon too…"

Is it because the words I heard earlier were so shocking? It was difficult to concentrate and listen to what was being said.

During the 45 days I slept, the world of the 41st round was thrown out of the orbit of the 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' I knew.

But if you ask me if it was bad, it wasn't all that bad.

'Disaster Scenario' and 'Peace Land' are scenarios that are difficult to clear smoothly even if I participated in person.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk cleared both scenarios perfectly on his own without any help.

Is this a development that also occurred in the original 41st round?

Or, is this a phenomenon that occurred because Han Sooyoung and I killed the founder of the Absolute Throne?

Kyung Sein added, perhaps because my expression seemed serious.

"Anyway, don't worry. The 41st round wasn't as bad as I thought. As expected, the 'Absolute Throne's' effect is good."

"Absolute Throne?"

Kyung Sein nodded at me as I asked in a stupid voice.

"Yes. Absolute Throne."

"Do you still have it?"

"Huh? Well… It didn't break in this round."

That couldn't have been possible.

Clearly, the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' is dead.

I saw it clearly with my own eyes.

"Who is the king? Is he among you?"

At my question, my companions turned to each other.

Kyung Sein smiled bitterly, and Lee Dansu shook his head.

Killer King looked proud, and Ye Hyunwoo burst into laughter.

"That can’t be possible, Inho-ssi. How can we become kings? The real king is alive and well."

I slowly got up from the bed. Perhaps because I had not moved my muscles for the first time in a while, my legs were shaking precariously.

I stood up unsteadily and saw the window of the hospital room beyond eye level.

It was.

「The tragedy of the 41st round begins with the 'Absolute Throne'.」

The scenery of Gwanghwamun unfolded outside the window.

An Absolute Throne occupying the center of the square. Who on earth could have occupied that throne in that chaos?

No matter how much I thought about it, there was only one person who had that possibility.

"Is it Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"Yes. He has taken the 'Absolute Throne'."

With Ye Hyunwoo’s low answer, I felt like something was falling apart.

What and where did it go wrong?

Did Han Sooyoung and I ultimately fail to change the development of this world?

"Fortunately."

Ye Hyunwoo said, squeezing my shoulder as if to reassure me.

"It’s a little different from the 41st round we expected. Although Yoo Joonghyuk won the 'Absolute Throne', he was unable to exercise the power of the ‘Absolute Throne."

Was the throne unable to exercise its power?

I suddenly turned my head and my eyes met Ye Hyunwoo's.

The moment I saw his calm eyes, I felt like I knew why he came here.

"So... that's what we're curious about. Inho-ssi, what on earth happened that day?"

Kyung Sein, Killer King, and Dansu ahjussi. Everyone was looking at me as if they had agreed to do so.

"On the day the 'Great Hall' opened, it was Yoo Joonghyuk who brought Inho-ssi back. But even when I asked Yoo Joonghyuk what happened, I couldn't get an answer."

It was natural.

Because he doesn't really know what happened that day.

"That day, Inho-ssi was wearing the 'Death Sword'. Did Inho-ssi cut down the link of 'Absolute Throne'?"

"I-"

I tried to speak.

It wasn't me who did it.

There was one more person there that you and I both knew.

"It's not me, it's Han Soo—"

[You can no longer use the 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'.]

The moment I heard the message, my tongue stiffened before I knew it.

『Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World.』

A skill that protected me after entering this world, and a novel that underpins the foundation of this world.

Kim Dokja's favorite story.

[You can no longer use 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'.]

There was someone who gave me this skill.

Someone who felt guilty about me.

The person who gave up all of her stories to save me.

I tried activating the skill again and again.

[You can no longer use 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'.]

The skill did not activate.

[You can no longer use 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'.]

The story that once protected Kim Dokja has now left me.

Probably with the writer who was trying to give me the story.

"Inho-ssi?"

Lee Dansu, who realized that my condition was strange, grabbed my shoulder and said,

"Everyone, Inho-ssi doesn't seem to be in good condition, so it would be better to ask later—"

"No, you have to ask right now. We've already waited a long time. 'That phenomenon' has been happening for 45 days."

The conversation between Ye Hyunwoo and Killer King could be heard through the buzzing of my ears.

"Dansu ahjussi, you know what the situation is right now. The only clue to the recent events is Inho-ssi."

"It's an oddity that even I, who've read Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint 100 times, can't figure out. The only person I can trust is that guy."

I don't know what's going on. But there was no answer I could give.

"I..."

The story I know is just the story you all know.

I am not as great a person as everyone thinks.

This is because although I am clearly the reincarnation of Kim Dokja, I am not the real Kim Dokja who read 'Ways of Survival'.

The real Kim Dokja.

Memories slowly returned with a slight headache.

Memories of the very day I killed the 'God of Another World'.

The reason I live here now.

「"I will make a contract."」

It slowly dawned on me.

In order to kill the 'God of the Other World', I made a sponsorship contract with that Constellation.

However, I could hardly feel his presence.

Even when I looked up into space or clenched and opened my fists, I didn't feel like anything had changed.

Tsutsutsutsu.

It was then that the smartphone on the table vibrated.

A message appeared on the smartphone screen.

[Someone requested a 'midday secret meeting'.]

At that moment, I realized something.

This was not the smartphone I had.

But I already knew who this smartphone belonged to.

[Applicant: Demon King of Salvation]

Perhaps this was the 'star relic' of my sponsor.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 681 Episode 22 Name (3)

As I was looking at the conversation request message that appeared before my eyes, I felt something strange.

Clearly, I have entered the world of 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint'.

I went through scenarios and met other characters from <Kim Dokja’s Company>.

[Applicant: Demon King of Salvation]

Nevertheless, the moment I saw that message, I felt like everything was losing its sense of reality.

I don't know why.

Actually, I guess I didn't believe that the real Kim Dokja existed in this world.

Maybe that's why I was so strangely shaken by the fact that Kim Dokja really exists.

Why on earth am I agitated?

With such complicated thoughts, I hesitantly touched it.

However.

[The sender has not paid the coins required for 'Midday Tryst'.]

I didn't understand what it meant, so I read the message over and over again. At first, I thought no way, but after a while I thought, damn it, and finally, I let out a hollow laugh.

Little by little, I felt a sense of reality coming back to life.

It's definitely true.

[A toll-free fee will be charged for 'Midday Tryst'.]

This kid is definitely Kim Dokja.

My hunch says so.

I sighed lightly and pressed the 'Confirm' button. Okay.

[The recipient has paid the fee.]

['Midday Tryst' has been linked.]

But nothing really changed.

Since he requested a conversation first, I thought he would say hello, but Kim Dokja was silent the whole time.

"Inho-ssi?"

People who felt something strange were looking at me.

I suddenly woke up and started fiddling with my smartphone like a crazy person, so it was natural.

I hesitated for a moment and then said this.

"Actually, I just got a text from Kim Dokja."

The four people stared at me at the same time. Their eyes were filled with different thoughts.

Eyes that wonder if I'm crazy (Ye Hyunwoo), eyes that are worried I may have hit my head (Kyung Sein), eyes that think it's a joke for young people these days (Lee Dansu), eyes that ask isn’t Kim Dokja me (Killer King)...

If it were 45 days ago, everyone would have been interested in what I said and would have asked questions.

Is it real? Did you really get in touch with Kim Dokja? Can we all live together now?

But they didn't.

It was proof that they had completely adapted to this world.

「In this world, there is no 'Demon King of Salvation' to save us.」

In order to survive in this world, readers have decided to forget the name of the greatest hope they know.

And it happened by itself.

That fact was somehow sad, so I had no choice but to make a joke out of the hope I had raised.

"I'm just kidding. What did you say you were curious about?"

Ye Hyunwoo, whose expression softened slightly at my words, began talking again.

To summarize, the four people's questions were simple.

"How did the fourth scenario end that day?"

After gathering my thoughts for a moment, I started talking.

First, when Han Sooyoung appeared.

"I guess that was Han Sooyoung?"

Kidnapped by Representative Kim Dokja along with the unconscious Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Was that Asmodeus?"

"Damn, that snarky tone was strange."

"I already knew."

And how I became convinced that 'Representative Kim Dokja' was Asmodeus; escaped from this guy's space using the 'Death Sword'; being thrown into the breakaway area;

fighting with Han Sooyoung against the 'God of the Other World', 'the Founder of the Absolute Throne'...

"An Outer God?"

"Was it really an Outer God who created the 'Absolute Throne'?"

"If Kim Dokja says it’s like that, then so be it."

Lastly, I even used stories to kill that guy.

Except for a few incidents that I can't tell them about yet, I briefly told my companions what happened that day.

"You killed the Outer God? So you also got the story?"

"Maybe."

While saying that, I opened the previous message log.

There was quite a backlog of logs that I had not been able to check for 45 days. Among them, there was also something about 'stories'.

[A temporary error has occurred in the <Star Stream>’s system.]

[The name of the new story has not been decided yet.]

[The management bureau is closely reviewing your story achievements.]

I still couldn't confirm the name or grade of my newly acquired story.

Is it because I fainted?

Or is it because I have achieved such unbelievable achievements?

If you think about it, I defeated the 'God of Another World', who had a wonderful name, in the early scenarios.

Since I achieved an unusual feat in only the fourth scenario, the Management Bureau and the <Star Stream> may also be embarrassed.

I don't know, but if it's about eradicating a 'God from Another World', it would be at least a 'semi-mythical level' story.

As soon as I receive the story, something will go wrong in the early scenarios ecosystem, so the Management Bureau may have noticed this and is intentionally putting the brakes on it.

Anyway, I have no choice but to give it up in the end.

"You have accomplished a great feat, Kim Dokja. Now you will become a little more like Kim Dokja."

"Wow... with that level of achievement, what kind of story would they give?"

Following the admiring Killer King and Kyung Sein, Dansu ahjussi also nodded as if he understood now.

"Then I guess that's why the power of the 'Absolute Throne' doesn't activate."

"I guess so."

After thinking about it for a while, I decided to postpone the story that there were readers in the theater's audience, and that among them was the man's daughter, Jiyoon.

The last question was asked by Ye Hyunwoo.

"What happened to Han Sooyoung."

"I don't know. She disappeared after that."

I didn't want to say that Han Sooyoung was dead. Because although she was definitely seen disappearing, it was entirely possible that it was an avatar.

The Han Sooyoung I know would have definitely prepared a way out somewhere.

"Hmm... First of all, I understood everything you told me."

After hearing my answer, Hyunwoo glanced at Killer King, and he disappeared out of the hospital room, saying he would talk for a while.

What happened in the meantime to make their faces look so serious?

I also had a lot of questions to ask.

What is the 'phenomenon' that occurred 45 days ago?

Is the seventh scenario the same as the 'seventh' I know?

What is Yoo Joonghyuk doing now?

What happened to 'Shin Yoosung' who was with me?

Clearly, that 'Shin Yoosung' was not the Shin Yoosung of this 41st world line.

Perhaps, like me and other readers, she is a being possessed from another world line that we know.

And that world line was most likely the 1,864th round when Kim Dokja was alive.

If I can meet Shin Yoosung again, I might be able to find out Han Sooyoung's whereabouts.

"Ugh."

Maybe it was because I suddenly moved my body, but belated pain came to all of my joints.

I asked for understanding with a bitter smile towards Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi, who were surprised and helped me.

"I'd like to take a look outside first."

---

After Yoo Joonghyuk gained the Absolute Throne, Seoul was completely pacified.

Of course, there were still those who did not sympathize with Yoo Joonghyuk, but at least the groups that had been torn apart and fighting against each other became one under the rule of the King.

"Where was this raid area?"

"Yeongdeungpo."

"I heard there were quite a few items?"

After listening to the stories of passing incarnations, the theme of the '7th Scenario' seemed to be 'Raid'.

This is a scenario where there are monsters designated as targets in each area, and the incarnations designated as raiders gather together with their allies to hunt the monsters.

The original seventh scenario was also 'monster hunting', so there was no major change in content.

I wondered if there was a monster designated as a target for me, too.

[There is currently no main scenario assigned to you.]

[The main scenario is being reassigned to you.]

Perhaps because I had been knocked out for so long, there were no separate scenarios assigned.

"So that meteorite—"

"Is it true? You found a meteorite there?"

I heard that the fifth scenario is finished, but there is still a story about meteorites now?

I don't know what is what.

I'll have to ask other people a little later.

"I'm going first this time, ahjussi."

"Come!"

In the square in front, Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi were sparring. I wondered why these people were suddenly sparring...

[Incarnation 'Kyung Sein' uses 'Tekken Lv.8'!]

When I saw it, I couldn't close my mouth.

Kyung Sein, who jumped up in the air, rained down heavy strikes, causing a cloud of dust to form on the rubbled floor.

Kyung Sein was not the only one who became stronger.

[Incarnation 'Lee Dansu' activates 'Cryptic Flower Lv.6'!]

Both of Dansu ahjussi's legs were covered with chitin like those of a grasshopper, and with his agile movements, he avoided all of Kyung Sein's iron fists.

"Wow. Are you used to it now? That's the evolution you got this time, right?"

"I got it from a grade 6 servant last time."

The gap of 45 days was large.

45 days ago, I was clearly at the forefront of the incarnations, but watching the battle between the two, I felt like I had no chance of winning if I clashed with my bare body.

How long have they been training?

No, who treated those two like that?

"Isn’t it amazing?"

When I turned around in surprise, there was an unexpected person standing there.

"Those two people had a really hard time working under Yoo Joonghyuk."

A unique, soft and calm voice. The woman's white hair was blowing in the wind.

"They’ve been training every single day since the day you were hospitalized."

I suddenly got up from my seat and bowed to Lee Seolhwa.

Lee Seolhwa smiled and held out her hand, as if she already knew me.

I smiled lightly and took her hand.

"You are Cheon Inho, right? I heard the story from people."

"Yes, that’s right."

"People say that if it weren’t for you, I would have been dead already."

Lee Seolhwa slowly looked around Gwanghwamun while speaking.

When I looked closely, I saw some familiar faces.

Dayoung and her mother from Geumho Station.

Sergeant Kim Heonyeol and Jung Heewon's younger brother Jung Eunho, who fought together with me against the Beggar Sect.

There was also Kim Namwoon, an 'insighter' whom I met on the way to Gwanghwamun.

"I wish I could hear those words from someone someday."

It seems that Lee Seolhwa in this round did not become an enemy.

Lee Seolhwa's voice as she expressed her honest impressions was clear.

I said, "I heard that you took care of me. I am late to greet you. If it weren't for Lee Seolhwa, I would probably have died."

"Do you know my name?"

"Of course."

"I made a bet with Jihye on whether Inho-ssi knows my name."

Lee Jihye from the 41st round was seen waving her hand in this direction from afar.

I said as I too shook her hand.

"There’s no way I wouldn’t know. You’re my benefactor. I’ve heard a lot of rumors about you."

"Rumors? I haven’t done much external activities."

I was sorry to say it.

Since Lee Seolhwa did not become evil in the 41st round, her name may not be known yet.

After thinking about it briefly, I said this.

"I’m a fan of Donguibogam."

"Do you know my sponsor?"

"How can you not know the best doctor on the peninsula?"

[The Constellation 'Donguibogam' greatly appreciates you and sponsors 100 coins.]

Once again, this is the feeling of having read 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' fully.

Lee Seolhwa, who was looking at the message in the air, said with a bitter smile.

"I think I understand why people like Inho-ssi."

"I will take it as a compliment."

"May I ask what Inho-ssi’s sponsor is?"

"My sponsor is-"

Originally, I had no intention of revealing my sponsor here, but I felt like I wanted to test it out.

I have expectations that the 'Lee Seolhwa' before my eyes might be a special Lee Seolhwa, like the Shin Yoosung I met.

"It is the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

At that moment, Lee Seolhwa’s expression changed strangely.

Although it was a little bit, I couldn't help but feel nervous.

In only the 41st round, and at such an early stage, Lee Seolhwa chose the path of good rather than evil.

If she responds to this modifier—

"The Demon King of Salvation? Hmm, this is the first time I’ve heard of this Constellation..."

Looking at her expression, it didn't seem like she was lying.

"This modifier... feels a bit similar to the Constellation that Namwoon signed with..."

She even seemed to think that I had signed a contract with a strange Constellation.

For me, it was a little unfair.

I admit that the modifier is a bit formal.

Still, he's the main character... he's a Constellation... but he's Mythical grade.

"The Demon King of Salvation... The Demon King of Salvation... Hmm... I think something comes to mind..."

What?

"Salvation... Salvation... Church of Salvation. Ah, now that I think about it, among the medicinal herbs I obtained from the Church of Salvation this time..."

Lee Seolhwa, who was mumbling something to herself, passed by me and walked briskly toward the hospital.

I didn't know it when I was writing the novel, but when I saw her in real life, she was a character with a slightly four-dimensional side.

Lee Seolhwa, who looked like a mad doctor, suddenly turned her back to me after walking away.

"By the way, since you're still a patient, you know you shouldn't move too much, right?"

"Ah yes."

"Even though everything looks better on the outside, it's really damaged on the inside. If you don't treat it properly, you'll get seriously ill later."

The friendly Mad Doctor left those words and walked away.

I looked back at the people training.

People sweating profusely and devoting themselves to training.

What Lee Seolhwa said was right.

Even those who look fine on the outside are probably festering on the inside.

How many times have they lost their beloved family and precious friends?

「"All misfortunes are ordinary. They seem special because they are captured in stories."」

When I thought about it that way, the way people wielded swords and spears looked a little different.

A scene that probably could not have been captured in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

Like the people in front of me right now, the characters in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' must have been desperately grieving in an unseen place.

What was Kim Dokja like?

Perhaps Kim Dokja, whom I read and wrote about, had many times that I was unaware of.

Hum.

It was then that the smartphone rang in my arms.

Has the time finally come?

I cleared my throat slightly and opened my mouth.

"Can you hear me?"

And finally the long-awaited moment came.

[Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' has accessed 'Midday Tryst'.]

As I read that message, I thought back to the past two years of writing and reading Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint over and over again.

Is the person floating in the sky right now the Kim Dokja I know?

I don't know. But,

—Hello.

That was my first encounter with the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"Hello."

It was our first greeting.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 682 Episode 22 Name (4)

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After saying the first word, I suddenly became nervous.

Kim Dokja gave a very rigid first greeting even though he was not my boss.

Maybe?

No. Still, it's a hint.

It's a Constellation.

"Um, hey, nice to meet you."

Without realizing it, another polite word came out.

Anyway, since this is my first time seeing him in real life, it would be right to be respectful.

But is this really my first time seeing him?

Come to think of it, I met Kim Dokja a few times in the 'Snowfield'.

What was Kim Dokja like? Did Kim Dokja also say 'hello'?

I thought about Kim Dokja’s face, who talked to me with a sad face in the Snowy Field.

—Oh yeah. Nice to meet you.

The moment I heard the first words, the image of Kim Dokja changed in my head.

His eyes, which were filled with faint sadness, became strangely lazy, and his friendly expression changed to that of an office worker exhausted from work.

—But is it okay if I contact you through this? 'Indirect messages' cost too much coin.

What?

"Oh, yes. Of course."

Even though I was thinking that, I ended up answering like that.

—Thank you.

Then there was silence for a moment again.

I waited.

One minute, two minutes, three minutes...

I wondered what kind of situation this was.

"Hey...?"

—Uh, wait a minute. What are you doing now?

It seems like he's somewhat cold-hearted, or his mind is preoccupied with something else.

What is certain is that he is different from the Kim Dokja I know.

"I guess you are doing something important..."

No. Come to think of it, 'Kim Dokja' might be busy.

Kim Dokja is an observer of this world.

Because if he wants to maintain this world, he'll have to be watching this world all the time.

Therefore-

—I’m looking at Ways of Survival.

Yes, Ways of Survival.

—This is a fun part.

Ways of Survival... TWSA?

—Now Yoo Joonghyuk...

?

—He had a fight with Poseidon...

For a moment, I thought I had read it wrong.

I narrowed my eyes even more and concentrated, reading the message that Kim Dokja had sent me.

—I was really surprised. Joonghyuk, this kid has already grown so much. So, in this round...

I read and reread.

So, Kim Dokja's message was roughly as follows.

Yoo Joonghyuk, that bastard. In the early rounds, the guy who was so scared of the Constellations and ran away has already grown so much.

...

Was it because he got spanked so many times by Pacheon Swordsman in the last round that he turned around, or was he hit in the back of the head again by Anna Croft and his head got a little weird?

...

So, the child who has just become a Transcendental Constellation is finally ready to take on Poseidon, a Mythical Constellation. What should I say about this? Should I say that his chest feels magnificent?

...

I felt like I was losing my mind.

Who am I talking to now?

—Anyway, that’s why Yoo Joonghyuk is in crisis...

It was me, not Yoo Joonghyuk, who was in crisis.

I know that Kim Dokja likes TWSA. But no matter how much Kim Dokja does, this is not the case. He couldn't have lost his social skills to this extent—no.

Since he is 'Kim Dokja', isn’t this correct?

I decided to calm down and revise my conversation strategy.

The opponent is Kim Dokja.

He is crazy about Ways of Survival.

Then.

"Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World is fun."

—Do you know TWSA?

"Sure."

—Oh?

It worked.

—You know something, huh? Anyway, when I wrote a recommendation like that, no one read it...

All Constellations are crazy about 'stories'.

After loving a story for a long time, the stars finally became the story itself.

Perhaps the story of Kim Dokja becoming a Constellation will be destroyed.

—What is your favorite episode of Ways of Survival.

"The episode where Yoo Joonghyuk dies."

—Yoo Joonghyuk dies all the time.

"That’s the fun part. Even though he always dies, he always decides to start living again."

Actually, I have never properly read 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'.

That's right, although I know 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint', I don't know the contents of 'Ways of Survival'.

Because I never wrote it.

Therefore, my answer just now was not from 'Ways of Survival', but the crudest and slyest reply that a person who knows Yoo Joonghyuk could give.

—Well, that makes sense.

"Yes?"

—But he wasn't always so strong.

You don't know if you haven't read 'Ways of Survival'. I was silent for a moment and then asked bluntly.

"...Do you find it fun to tease me?"

It seemed like a mischievous laugh could be heard from somewhere.

It was a bit of a sigh, but it seemed like he was ready to start a full-fledged conversation.

"Are you aware that this is our first encounter as Constellation and incarnation?"

—Um, well.

"But from the first greeting, do you start talking about Ways of Survival? We introduce each other and say simple first names. That’s the normal, social way of communicating."

—It's social... It's been a while since I heard someone say that.

I felt a strange sense of longing in his bitter tone.

Is he thinking of someone?

If you think about it, it was right after the apocalypse began that Kim Dokja became a social person.

—Good. Well then, let me introduce myself first.

As if stretching, Kim Dokja introduced himself.

—I am the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

A simple and clear introduction.

The Demon King of Salvation.

That was the modifier of someone called 'Kim Dokja'.

"I am..."

—Now Cheon Inho. Your real name is Lee Hakhyun. A person from another world line possessing someone.

"You know very well."

I said in a shaky voice.

But. It's strange that he doesn't know, since he’s probably been watching me all along.

"Then I guess you know what the current situation is."

-What is the situation now?

"You were watching. No, we met and talked in a dream last time. Have you forgotten?"

—Dream? Isn’t this my first time talking to you?

I paused. As expected, this 'Kim Dokja' who spoke to me was not the Kim Dokja I met in 'Snowfield'.

Then who is 'Kim Dokja'?

And this 'Kim Dokja' I am talking to is someone else,

"Then, Kim Dokja, who talked to me in the 'Snowfield'..."

—What does that person look like?

"He just looks like Kim Dokja."

—There must be an atmosphere or something like that.

"I guess I should say he feels a bit sad."

—He’s sad... Is it the Second child? Or not...

Second?

—Anyway, he's not me. It's my first time meeting you, and honestly, I'm not that interested in you.

Yes. You are so cold-hearted.

—Your story is honestly not interesting.

It's not fun.

I was a little taken aback because I never expected to hear such words from Kim Dokja.

—It is too heavy and dark. As for your actions and judgments, it feels like something that befits the main character is missing.

"Well, I—"

I wanted to protest.

It's natural because I'm not the main character.

But am I qualified to say that now?

Even though I have no complete memories of my past life, I am here now because of my past life.

I came here only because I wanted to have my own story and find out who I was.

What remains is that I have the right to say such things on such a topic.

Do I?

—If you drag along the stories attached to you like shackles, one day you will be weighed down by those stories. You’re the Youngest.

After reading the message in a daze, I suddenly looked up.

"What did you just say?"

—You’re going to die from being crushed by stories.

"Not that, what you said after."

The Youngest.

Apparently he called me that.

—Ah.

The Demon King of Salvation spoke in a bored tone, as if he were counting the numbers of rounds of 'Ways of Survival'.

—That’s because you are the 'last Kim Dokja'.

---

From the moment I found out I was part of Kim Dokja, I had an idea.

"Perhaps there is more than one Kim Dokja in this world."

If you think about it, it wasn't an impossible story.

I am the reincarnation of 49% Kim Dokja.

If so, other Kim Dokjas also exist in a similar form.

There is a good possibility that it can be done.

And perhaps one of those 'Kim Dokjas' is ripping me off right now.

—Hey, just give me 500 coins.

"No."

—If you just pay 500 more coins, I can switch to voice chat. It's inconvenient to send and receive messages through messages, so hurry up.

[500 coins were used.]

[The convenience feature of Midday Tryst has been added.]

I saw that my coins were being extorted. It occurred to me that I may have been mistaken about Kim Dokja all this time.

Wasn’t Kim Dokja originally a bad guy?

"So you are the 'First'?"

—Yes.

The clear voice of Kim Dokja echoed in my head. Right. It's definitely the voice of Kim Dokja that I imagined.

—You called me.

"Who I called is 'Kim Dokja'."

I miss Kim Dokja in the Snowfield.

Where did the kind and handsome Kim Dokja go, and why did a gangster appear wearing Kim Dokja's mask?

—No. You called the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Yes, that's right. What's the difference?

—You don't know what that means?

There was a memory that came to mind at that moment.

At the time when I was fighting with the God of the Other World, 'the Founder of the Absolute Throne', I called Kim Dokja for a sponsorship contract.

To be precise, I called 'Kim Dokja’s modifier'.

As far as I know, Kim Dokja has a total of four names.

And the only one that responded to me was the Demon King of Salvation in front of me.

"Wait a minute, then what you mean by 'First' is..."

—That's right. 'The order in which the modifiers were created'.

Kim Dokja's first modifier is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

He is a being who was reborn as a Constellation by having the story of 'King of a Kingless World' as his birth story and obtaining the story of 'Demon King of Salvation' on the last floor of the Dark Castle.

The story that made up him began to become visible. Little by little, I began to guess his identity.

"So, 'Kim Dokja' is divided by modifiers?"

—Well, excluding the small fragments, I guess the big chunk was broken up like that. I am the first among them.

Seeing that he put a lot of emphasis on being the firstborn, it seemed like he was quite proud of it.

Anyway, it was a disappointing situation for me.

"Then you are not 'Kim Dokja'."

If this Kim Dokja is the 'Demon King of Salvation', there is a high probability that he only has memories related to the story of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

According to his self-introduction, he is not Kim Dokja but the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

—It's not? I am not Kim Dokja?

"You are the Demon King of Salvation."

— Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation'. If I don't have all the stories related to Kim Dokja, does that mean I’m not Kim Dokja?

"Not really."

—I am Kim Dokja. If I'm not Kim Dokja, who on earth is Kim Dokja?

Who is it?

I thought I was jealous of that confidence.

Perhaps what makes Kim Dokja Kim Dokja is not Kim Dokja's memories but his attitude.

—By the way, I didn’t know you would call me. Should I say I'm lucky or unlucky?

"What does it mean?"

—This isn't the first time I've been involved in a 'sponsorship contract' with you.

This time too, a memory came to mind.

When the 41st round had just begun and the first scenario named 'Proof of Value' was over, I found a rather unusual modifier in the 'sponsorship list'.

"Surely that was you?"

The only three question marks that came up on the list of hints.

As expected, it seems Kim Dokja was right.

—To be exact, it was me and other Kim Dokjas.

Other Kim Dokjas?

—There was no separation back then.

Kim Dokja grumbled slightly and continued.

—Anyway, what went wrong then? In the process of contacting you, a separation occurred. I also left at that time.

In other words, at the beginning of this round, Kim Dokja was not several, but one.

"Why on earth did that happen? Who made you-"

—I don't know. Because I don’t have detailed memories of that time.

Anyway, he was torn apart and now exists as the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Kim Dokja yawned lightly as if it was no big deal and continued.

—By the way, you are the youngest. Isn’t there a reason you called me?

The reason for calling Kim Dokja.

"Yes, there is."

But when I tried to open my mouth, no words came out.

What should I ask first?

Should I ask for advice on how and what I should do from now on to reach the end of the scenarios?

Should I ask why the 41st round started and if he knows anything about Han Sooyoung's whereabouts?

No. Maybe what I really want to ask is-

—It seems like you have all the frustrating aspects of 'Kim Dokja'.

Hearing those words not from anyone else but from Kim Dokja makes me feel like I'm losing confidence.

Perhaps Kim Dokja didn't like the sight of me like that.

I sighed.

—Ugh, yeah. First, let's look at it from the beginning. What are your specifications? What are your overall abilities? What are your characteristics? There are no people around to listen, so you can speak comfortably.

"That is..."

The answer came out of nowhere to a sudden barrage of questions.

What are your overall abilities and what characteristics do you have...

"I don't know all the characteristics. I also can't see my Attributes' Window. Ah, I recently acquired the trait called [Circulatory Retardation], but-"

—What skills can you use?

"Not that many. With [Sentence Strengthening], [Incite]..."

Kim Dokja listened to my story in silence. Perhaps I was overwhelmed by his calmness, but before I knew it, I was continuing the conversation in a calm voice.

"And..."

As I continued to talk, my mind cleared up little by little.

It felt like the time I had crossed into this world and lived as 'Cheon Inho' unfolded clearly before my eyes.

—What are your items?

"My main item is this bracelet. It's an item called 'Thoughts of Almost Everything', and it can be transformed into a weapon of my choice using the mimicry function.

—What about the stories?

"I have two."

—What?

I recited two stories I had.

One was obtained by defeating the 'God of Another World' at Seoul Station called 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear'.

And the second was 'Tenacious Martial Arts Master' received from the Ark of the Beggar Sect.

"There will be one more soon. I have dealt with a fairly high-ranking god from another world. Even if it isn’t mythical, I will receive a 'semi-mythical grade' story."

Once again, I thought that these were not bad specs.

In the seventh scenario, there are already three stories.

Even though I was unconscious for 45 days, this is enough.

It's an achievement.

Maybe I was looking at the situation too pessimistically.

Actually, Kim Dokja's tone wasn't that bad.

—Well, that's about it for the seventh scenario.

Kim Dokja's signature smile flashed across my eyes.

I felt like an aspiring writer whose work was being appreciated for the first time.

How does my sponsor, who loves stories more than anyone else, evaluate the time I have lived?

—Are you by any chance an 'Immortal King'?

"I am not."

In this round, the 'Immortal King' was the characteristic of Lee Dansu.

—What about 'Eight Lives'?

"I haven’t even been near Peace Land."

'Eight Lives' was an attribute that could be obtained by defeating Yamata no Orochi in Peace Land.

—Have you signed a resurrection contract with <Eden>?

"Is it possible that such a large contract would be possible at such an early stage?"

—Okay. I didn't ask because I was expecting it either.

"Then why did you ask?"

Actually, why did he ask? There was no need to ask why.

—I thought I was going to fall asleep soon.

That was the 'Demon King of Salvation'’s first evaluation of me, Lee Hakhyun.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 683 Episode 22 Name (5)

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At first, I wanted to argue.

After falling into this world out of nowhere, I lived quite diligently.

In order to survive, I risked my life and nearly died.

Even though I couldn't live like Kim Dokja, I thought I still had something to say.

—Do you know what [Circulatory Delay] is?

I thought about it.

—Why can’t [Incite] be used like that?

It was like that until Kim Dokja, the Demon King of Salvation, started like rapid-fire.

—There is a good item like 'Thought', so why can’t you use it so much? What do you do when you rest? Didn’t you register the mimicry shapes of other items?

—Do you know how to use other stories besides [Persistent Murim Master]?

—And that's not all the skills you've gained. Why don't you use them? Can’t you practice skill linking?

—Why didn’t you learn any other combat skills besides [White Blue Energy]? Does it make sense that there is no [Weapon Polishing] right now?

I feel like I'm losing my mind.

Who said he was a living snout?

—I feel angry while talking. I know why I wasn't looking at you.

"No, don’t be so angry."

—Why are you calling me now? You want me to restore the mess you made?

Every word is painful. Perhaps because what he said was true.

What was I thinking when Yoo Joonghyuk fainted in the 41st round and even Han Sooyoung, whom I trusted, disappeared?

"I was shameless."

A sponsorship contract was the last option I could make.

In the spirit of grasping at the last straw to save this world, I called one person's name again and again and again.

I can offer anything in return, so please save this world.

I said.

"Help me. You can do it."

He is Kim Dokja.

The main character of this story.

"I don’t want to ruin this world anymore."

Even if I can't, he can. He could probably rewrite the story I ruined.

"I want to save people."

There were still many people left in Gwanghwamun.

People from this world that I was lucky enough to save, including readers like Dansu ahjussi and Kyung Sein.

Bang Cheolsoo and the mother and daughter at Geumho Station.

Sergeant Kim Hyunyeol and Jung Eunho at Seoul Station.

Jung Heewon and other colleagues who are probably executing a scenario somewhere.

And.

"Everything, including the dead people."

Even the readers I couldn’t save.

"You can do it."

It would be possible for Kim Dokja, an observer of this world.

As he proved in his previous life, he may be able to change the sentences already written on the 'Final Wall'.

—Why don’t you just ask for a regression?

—Of course I won’t let you do it. I can't let you do it.

"I don’t even want it. What I want to protect is this world."

This '41st round' only happens once.

If I return, I will be the only one who disappears from this world.

A new 42nd round will just be born.

"I hope this world doesn’t end."

—It's a destroyed world.

I know. But.

"It’s not written down."

—What?

"Nowhere in the novels you and I have read does it mention the destruction of this world line."

Of course, that doesn't mean it isn't written down at all.

Only once, in the 41st round, is the story told. By Shin Yoosung herself from the 41st round.

"Shin Sooyoung's statement is only a 'statement'. What really happened in the '41st round' is not recorded anywhere in the 'Ways of Survival'. Isn't that right?"

—You... That's an interesting story.

"Now you seem to be having fun."

It is interesting. It's a painful expression, but it's nice to have that feeling now. It doesn't matter if this world is someone's interest or entertainment. I was prepared to do anything if it could save this world.

—But in order to carry out what you think, you will end up having to do something in this world. You have to reach the end. You know what that means, right?

The end of the world. A place where there is the 'Last Wall' where everything in the universe is written.

To get there I have to clear all the main scenarios.

"I do."

—Can you do it?

I shook my head.

What can a person who faints for 45 days after only passing four scenarios do? But.

"I can't do it alone."

My sponsor is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

The master of the [Fourth Wall] and the greatest deity in the universe.

"Please join me at the end of the scenarios one more time."

I trusted Kim Dokja.

If it is Kim Dokja, who loves stories more than anyone else in the world, I once believed that I could wonder about the end of this world.

So I gave up becoming a Constellation and signed a contract with him.

—That’s easier said than done, man. It gives people trouble.

"Is it because of probability?"

Clearly, probability was an important issue. No matter how strong Kim Dokja is, the <Star Stream>'s probability system is something that cannot be ignored.

—No, I have to read Ways of Survival.

"What the hell are you..."

I was so dumbfounded for a moment that I tried to say something but held back.

Why on earth does he keep reading about these damn Ways of Survival? Is it because of the attributes of the 'Demon King of Salvation'?

I don't know.

However, seeing as he is so obsessed with reading, there may be an inevitable reason for him.

I took note of that.

"If we are to be honest, this world is also part of 'Ways of Survival'."

—Not really.

"Are you just going to watch the world of Ways of Survival become ruined? You already signed a contract with me."

—Hmm.

"Please help me. I will do anything as long as you help me."

I said all I could out of anger, but after saying it, I felt a little embarrassed.

The opponent is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

He is a being who has already seen the end of the world, and is a great person whose name was included in the 'Mythical grade Constellations'.

There was no way I could convince such a being that I would do anything.

Should we instead use other incentives related to the 'Ways of Survival'?

I thought.

—You will do anything?

Kim Dokja showed an unexpected reaction.

I asked with urgency.

"Are you going to help me?"

Kim Dokja was silent for a moment, as if he was worried about something.

Also, did he go to read Ways of Survival?

"Hey, Inho-ssi."

It was then that someone called me.

When I looked back, I saw someone who looked a head taller than me. It was a face I knew well.

"Oh, hello."

"Yes. Are you feeling okay?"

Lee Hyunsung, wiping the sweat from his forehead, was smiling his signature gentle smile.

By the way, it seems like his body had grown again in 45 days. How could a person, not even in his growing phase, do this?

"Yes, thank you."

Did he come because he was worried about me?

I don't know. Lee Hyunsung may have a friendly personality, but does he care enough about me as a member of the group?

It was then that my sponsor, who had disappeared for a while, returned.

—Uh? This is Lee Hyunsung.

Although he didn't say anything specific, I could tell what he was thinking just from the tone of his voice.

—Hmm, look at this.

Kim Dokja was currently analyzing Lee Hyunsung.

—In the seventh scenario, how much must Lee Hyunsung have to do to get to that point... Does Yoo Joonghyuk here also have a story about the [Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk]?

I left the 'Demon King of Salvation' alone and asked Lee Hyunsung.

"Hey, what’s going on?"

Then Lee Hyunsung, who hesitated, slowly nodded his head.

"The Captain is looking for you."

Yoo Joonghyuk? Me?

Lee Hyunsung must have read my expression and quickly opened his mouth.

It's probably not a big deal and he’ll tell me to take it easy.

"I... But I think it would be a good idea to be a little more careful."

Huh?

"The Captain seemed very angry."

"Angry? At me?"

"I don’t know about that, but if things continue like this, he’ll definitely kill you... You’ve been saying strange things to yourself."

Suddenly, my mind went blank.

In hindsight, I thought carefully about what I had been doing 45 days ago.

However, it didn't seem like I had done anything majorly wrong to Yoo Joonghyuk.

Although I had confrontations with Yoo Joonghyuk several times during the scenario...

Although I prevented Yoo Joonghyuk from taking the 'Absolute Throne'...

There was also a time when I used a fainted Yoo Joonghyuk as a shield to block an attack from Asmodeus...

"Can I not go?"

Then Lee Hyunsung laughed bitterly.

"He said 'Be sure to bring him'..."

Fuck.

—Good.

A voice calmly says that it is not his business.

I frowned at the sky and muttered with my mouth.

'What's so good about it?'

—The main character is calling you personally.

'They say if I come, he'll kill me.'

—At least until you die, you still have some usefulness left in this world.

Is this what Kim Dokja meant when he said that I would soon fall apart?

If I could read 'Ways of Survival' like Kim Dokja, I would be able to get at least a hint on how to survive in a situation like this.

[You can no longer use 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'.]

But I no longer have 'Ways of Survival'.

—Why is Ways of Survival necessary?

"Ah."

For a moment, I forgot who I signed with.

Yes.

Now that I think about it, I no longer need Ways of Survival.

—Now, let’s go take a look at the back of Joonghyuk’s head in the 41st round.

Because right now, my Constellation knew Yoo Joonghyuk better than anyone else in this world.

---

Inside Gwanghwamun. Yoo Joonghyuk was sitting cross-legged, shirtless, in a temporary shelter created by remodeling the inside of Gyeongbokgung Palace.

On Yoo Joonghyuk's back, where his sculpted muscles were exposed, several engravings reminiscent of tattoos were engraved.

「Redemption of truth」

「Restraint of Emotions」

「Redemption of Life」

These were the imprints of the story that were sequentially engraved on his body as he entered this round.

The more his body accumulates, the more powerful he becomes.

Carving three stories into a body that had not yet passed the tenth scenario was tantamount to suicide, but he did not hesitate.

Shoooooo.

After a while, pure white steam rose from Yoo Joonghyuk's upper body. The process of gradually settling the imbalances in the body, eliminating waste from the body, and advancing to a higher state.

The road to Transcendence.

It was a transcendental leap that he would not normally attempt at this stage, but this time, Yoo Joonghyuk was anxious.

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is looking at you.]

[The Constellation 'Lilies in Aquarius' covers the eyes of the 'Demon-like Judge of Fire'.]

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' picks his ears with his headband.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' says that if he takes off his clothes, he will be like that.]

His concentration was scattered because of the noisy Constellations. He tried to endure it several times, but hewas now at his limit.

"Shut up."

The magical power that had been neatly refined was absorbed in an instant, and Yoo Joonghyuk let out a deep breath.

He frowned as he picked up his clothes and coat from the floor.

His clothes were scattered in a mess, just like this round.

Because.

Even thinking about it again, there was something strange about this round. The Constellations in the sky, the incarnations that follow him, and.

'Cheon Inho.'

That strange guy and the name they keep muttering.

'Kim Dokja.'

He didn’t know why, but the incarnations of this world kept saying that name.

This was especially true for incarnations that had not been active in previous rounds.

For example, that idiotic incarnation of Jophiel who keeps imitating his way of speaking.

—What do you usually eat?

—At what time do you usually go to bed and at what time do you wake up?

—Do you also do intermittent fasting or something like that?

If Lee Hyunsung hadn't stopped him, he would have smashed the head of the guy who kept asking about pointless things multiple times.

—But really, doesn’t anything come to mind when you hear the name 'Kim Dokja'?

A throbbing pain rose in his temple, and memories of 45 days ago suddenly flashed through his mind.

With the 'Absolute Throne' in front of him, he fought with an incarnation.

A woman named Han Sooyoung.

She knew he was a Regressor. A being stronger than any other incarnation encountered in this round.

When he came to hissenses after the fight, Yoo Joonghyuk realized that she had disappeared from this world.

What was left behind when she disappeared were the memories she had planted in his head after delving into his mind.

「"Just let go already and get lost, you damn bastard."」

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk’s colleague who came back alive."」

A face that was hard to remember, as mushy as dough that has been rolled out.

「"Hello, Joonghyuk. How are you? Your face looks nice."」

In the process of recalling that memory again and again, Yoo Joonghyuk realized that these memories were not his own, but memories of another world.

Normally, he wouldn't have been so agitated just because such a world existed.

If only he hadn't heard those words in his memory.

「"Yoo Joonghyuk. Come to your senses. Don’t be mistaken in thinking that it will get better if you repeat it a few times."」

A voice that resonates loudly as if cutting out his entire life.

「"Even if you save the world, you will not be saved. The moment you save the world, the worlds you abandoned will come upon you. Even if you save one world, all the other

worlds you abandoned will drag you to hell."」

「"Don't be fooled into thinking that throwing away this round will make the next round better. Maybe the round you are trying to throw away is the only round where you can see the end of this world as a 'human'."」

While living in the 41st round, no one had ever said anything like that to him.

And luckily, the Yoo Joonghyuk in his memories was able to hear words he had never heard.

And in only the 3rd round.

In a state of innocence unpolluted by the tragedies of this world.

He doesn't know what happened to Yoo Joonghyuk of that world line after that.

But one thing is certain. Something must have changed about that Yoo Joonghyuk. And if he was lucky, he might have seen the end of the world as a true human.

The bitter smile on his lips right now was probably self-deprecation about the years he had lived. A mockery of the time when he endured tragedy more desperately than anyone else.

「"In return for enduring that long time, he was no longer 'human'."」

He was Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round.

The only round where humans could see the end of the world.

Now all that was left in his life was tragedy.

Eternal punishment given to him who chose to [Regress].

The world he abandoned will continue to haunt him like a curse.

Even if all scenarios are cleared, salvation will not be given to him.

The moment he thought like that.

"Yay!"

As if to punish his thoughts, someone hit him on the back of the head.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 684 Episode 22 Name (6)

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At first, of course I thought it was a joke.

—Hit Yoo Joonghyuk in the back of the head.

"Huh?"

Because no sane person would make such a suggestion.

—Then I will help you.

No, seriously?

Why?

—Because I miss it.

"Why do you want to see that?"

It was a difficult question to ask.

I guess he said he wanted to see it because it was fun. The 'Demon King of Salvation' is a Constellation after all.

No, before he was a Constellation, that person actually liked hitting Yoo Joonghyuk in the back of the head.

Not only in the 3rd round, but also in the 1,863rd round, he was a heinous great man who hit Yoo Joonghyuk on the back of the head and made him eat dirt.

If you think about it, it was a strange thing.

Why did Kim Dokja do such a thing?

Is he naturally a bit sadistic?

—Why? Can't you do it? Did you ask for help without that much courage?

"No, being courageous and being crazy are different."

—If you can’t do it, quit. You don't need my help, right?

"No! I need it! I need it!"

I calmed down and thought about this proposal again.

If you think about it, Kim Dokja’s actions were thoroughly calculated throughout the scenarios.

From an item picked up during a scenario to a paving stone laid in advance, Kim Dokja was the person who prepared for the very distant future.

That guy told me to hit Yoo Joonghyuk in the back of the head.

If so, there must be a reason.

Tak!

I believed so. Until I heard a clicking sound from my palm.

The moment my eyes met with Yoo Joonghyuk’s, who slowly turned his head. I realized what I had done.

A terrifying look that seems to freeze even your heart. Pupils glowing with terrible heat glared at me.

First of all, to make the facts clear, I did not properly hit Yoo Joonghyuk in the back of the head.

To be exact, I just hit the magic barrier between the back of Yoo Joonghyuk's head and my palm.

[Incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk''s skill 'Self-Defense Lv.10' is being activated.]

In the seventh scenario, the self-defense level is as high as level 10.

This was an opponent on whom an attack from the back of the head would not work.

'What should I do now?'

Anyway, I kept my promise to Kim Dokja.

From now on, it's up to Kim Dokja.

—You really did this.

'Huh?'

—I didn't know you would really do it.

Are you crazy?

Lately, another piece of information about Kim Dokja came to mind.

Clearly, Kim Dokja plans everything thoroughly.

However, did this person have a plan when he hit Yoo Joonghyuk?

"What are you doing?"

My back straightened and my spine went numb. It became clear to me that if this continued, I would die.

What on earth have I done?

Why did I hit Yoo Joonghyuk in the back of the head?

To the guy who already has a grudge against me-

[Exclusive characteristics are activated!]

Is it because I was in danger? Suddenly, my head became clear and my mind became clearer.

This became clear.

Let's live. I have to survive somehow.

To Yoo Joonghyuk, I am now Cheon Inho.

If I were Cheon Inho, what would I say to Yoo Joonghyuk now?

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated!]

Equipped with the special Cheon Inho mode, my narrowed eyes twirled in a gentle arc.

"Your skill proficiency is amazing. I wouldn’t have been able to stop you in my last life."

Yoo Joonghyuk's expression, who had been rolling his eyes at my shameless tone, changed completely.

"Did you regain your memories from the last round?"

I just shrugged my shoulders without answering. However, Yoo Joonghyuk’s answer was unexpected.

"Stop acting. I already know that you are not 'Cheon Inho'."

I swallowed my embarrassment.

I knew that Yoo Joonghyuk was suspicious of me.

But I never thought he would bring that up out loud.

"Why do you think that?"

"If you were really Cheon Inho, you would have aimed for a more obvious vital point."

"Then let’s use the fake Cheon Inho. After all, who I am doesn't matter, right?"

"It wasn’t important. Originally."

With those words, Yoo Joonghyuk put on his coat.

After that, he sat down on a chair and started gulping down the drink on the table. Even as he drank his drink, he did not take his eyes off the clear sky outside the window.

I could see what Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at.

In the center of the cloudless sky, there remained traces as if someone had grabbed the space itself and ripped it away.

This was from the award ceremony 45 days ago, when the 'Great Hall' disappeared.

Beyond the sky, me and Yoo Joonghyuk fought Asmodeus, then I faced off against the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

Does Yoo Joonghyuk remember what happened that day?

—Also.

Kim Dokja, who was watching Yoo Joonghyuk with me, said.

—He’s not killing you.

I was dumbfounded. Did he make me hit the head of Yoo Joonghyuk just to test it?

—You've learned that he won't kill you anyway. This is important. I don't know how many more times I'm going to have to hit that guy in the back of the head from now on.

'I won't hit him anymore.'

Yoo Joonghyuk, who must have sensed my gaze, put down his glass and opened his mouth.

"Fake Cheon Inho."

"Yes."

"Why did you stop me from taking the Absolute Throne?"

"You took it in the end."

"I know what you did."

Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body slowly looked back at me, showing the power of a king.

But that was only a matter of momentum, and it didn't actually have any influence on me.

In this round, it was proof that the 'Absolute Throne' was not functioning properly.

"How did you kill the 'God of Another World'?"

"I was lucky."

"Why on earth did you do that?"

"You will never see a proper ending if you take the throne."

"How do you know that?"

"You're a Regressor and you still don't know that?"

In the meantime, did the 'Demon King of Salvation' Kim Dokja's tone affected mine? Without realizing it, I came up with a sharp answer.

Yoo Joonghyuk's reaction was clear.

"You."

Yoo Joonghyuk acted as if he was going to kill him this time.

I started gulping on my saliva without realizing it.

—Don't be scared. He won't kill you.

I also agreed with what Kim Dokja said.

Yoo Joonghyuk can't kill me now.

In fact, Yoo Joonghyuk's murderous spirit, who was glaring at me, slowly subsided. Yoo Joonghyuk made his decision.

Rather than killing me here and now. It's better to use me.

—It's not a very bad situation. You have been recognized by Joonghyuk, right?

Recognized by Yoo Joonghyuk.

That sounds like I haven't lived very wrongly.

I didn't feel bad inside.

Yoo Joonghyuk continued speaking.

"That day, there was someone other than you who stopped me."

I could immediately tell who Yoo Joonghyuk was talking about.

That was a story about Han Sooyoung.

"She planted a memory in my head."

"What memory?"

"A memory from another world line."

Even though it was something I expected, I got goosebumps again.

Not another Yoo Joonghyuk, but Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round learned about the world line of『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

I was curious about Kim Dokja's reaction, but he didn't say anything.

"Do you know that world line too?"

"I do."

I became curious for a moment.

How does Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round view the world of『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』?

What did he feel when he saw the story of that world?

"Can you do something similar as that woman?"

"Huh?"

"I'm asking if you can plant the memories of that world line in my head."

Like Han Sooyoung, I did not have the complete story of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

But if I were to simply inject what happened in that world line, I might be able to imitate it similarly.

Because I have [Incite].

"If you turn off [Mental Barrier], I can do it, however clumsily. Are you curious about the story of that world line?"

I was worried for a moment.

If Yoo Joonghyuk says he wants to know that world line, should I tell him the story?

If that happens, what will happen to this 41st round?

"I’m not curious about the story."

Yoo Joonghyuk said that and frowned again, I wondered what he was thinking. Then he opened his mouth as if sighing lightly.

"I received a call from Anna Croft a little while ago."

It was a name I hadn’t heard in a long time.

Anna Croft.

The representative incarnation of <Asgard>. She is the representative of the American group.

"That woman’s group will join the final battle of the seventh scenario."

"You mean Zarathustra?"

"It seems like you know."

I nodded.

In fact, I had used the Specter's Stone to meet Anna Croft.

I had a brief conversation with her.

"Are you planning to join forces with her?"

To be honest, I was surprised.

I don't know what happened in the 40th round, but the Yoo Joonghyuk I know was never the type of person to join forces with 'Anna Croft'.

Of course, things will change when we enter the later episodes of 'Ways of Survival', but this is only the 41st round.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who has not forgotten any of the tragedy that occurred in the last round... will he be able to cooperate with that 'Anna Croft'?

"If I ever meet Anna Croft, I'll probably kill her."

With those words, a strange sensation arose throughout Yoo Jonhyuk's body.

It was a sense of an unsettling story.

At the same time, Kim Dokja's voice was heard.

—Damn, that kid got that tattooed on his body in only the seventh scenario?

Kim Dokja seemed to recognize what Yoo Joonghyuk's story was.

"Anna Croft is still useful. She has work to do, at least until the world ends. So if I'm going to kill her..."

Yoo Joonghyuk took a slow breath as if to calm himself down.

"You should stop it."

"Huh?"

"Infuse me with memories of another world line."

"What... if I do something like that?"

"Then I can stop."

Goosebumps slowly appeared down my spine.

Only then did I start to understand why Yoo Joonghyuk kept me alive.

"I don't really know why, but when I receive these memories, I stop acting."

「Happy memories.」

I don't know what happened to Yoo Joonghyuk's inner self after receiving his memories.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk was speaking.

"I don't know if you are Cheon Inho or not. But you will stay next to me and stop me when I give you an order."

Stop him when he orders me to.

"That’s your usefulness."

I understood what Yoo Joonghyuk meant. That's why I couldn't believe it.

—Congratulations, Youngest. Looks like this is going to work out well.

Just now, I was officially recognized by Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round.

"This is an order. Join this scenario."

Become his companion to prevent the destruction of this world.

'Constellation-nim.'

—Huh.

The moment when the first ray of light shone in the 41st world, which was filled with all kinds of gloomy prospects.

Maybe it is not too late for the 41st round. This story can still be changed.

As expected, Kim Dokja spoke in an even more excited voice as if he was moved.

—Next time you hit him in the back of the head, let’s inject a memory where I made him eat dirt.

I ignored Kim Dokja’s nonsense and checked my smartphone. That was because a vibration rang at that moment.

[A new episode of 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' has been updated on the platform.]

And then I realized I had forgotten I had this ability.

The ability to check 'comments' on episodes posted on the platform. If I used this ability, not only what happened in the last 45 days. I may also be able to get hints about future events.

With that in mind, I clicked on the platform app... How did this happen?

The series from the last 45 days in which I fainted did not exist.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 685 Episode 22 Name (7)

"Departure is in one hour. When you are ready, come to the throne room in Gwanghwamun."

After completing the one-sided notification, Yoo Joonghyuk sat cross-legged again and closed his eyes.

I immediately left Yoo Joonghyuk and headed to the Gwanghwamun tent village where people were gathered.

While moving, I had a brief chat with Kim Dokja.

—That’s an interesting ability. You mean you can only read the comments and not the text?

'Yes.'

Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation' who shared my vision, was busy looking at the platform app linked to his smartphone.

…

Episode 22. Name (3) +[8]

Episode 22. Name (2) +[11]

Episode 22. Name (1) +[14]

…

It appears that the app can be shared on the smartphone received as a relic.

Just by looking briefly, Kim Dokja seemed to realize what the situation was.

—Your story is being serialized here in real time.

'I think so.'

If you think about it, Kim Dokja also experienced something similar.

At that time, it was not a Side Story, but a revised version of Ways of Survival.

—There was quite a long break from the series between episodes 21 and 22.

The break period between episodes 21 and 22 is exactly 45 days.

'It’s the same amount of time I was unconscious.'

That means that this 'serialization' is recorded only when I am awake.

'Who is serializing it?'

The original author of 'Ways of Survival' and 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' was Han Sooyoung.

So, is it her who is writing this series?

Of course, Han Sooyoung died right before my eyes.

But... there's no way she really died. The Han Sooyoung I know would definitely survived that.

—How do I know that?

'You can observe the whole universe.'

—That's what the Oldest Dream does.

When I think about it, his current identity was the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

I had a strange feeling.

What was his Constellation level?

'What grade are you: historical-grade, narrative grade, or mythical grade?'

In the original work, Kim Dokja's final grade was 'myth level'.

However, according to Kim Dokja, the Demon King of Salvation, the Kim Dokja I know was divided around 'modifiers'. That means...

—Let’s read the comments first. Try a free ticket.

Looking at the way he was changing the subject, I guess he wasn’t a mythical grade.

[One free daily pass will be deducted.]

Anyway, the suggestion to read the comments itself wasn't bad. Because I needed as much information as possible right now.

I clicked on the comments for the most recent episode.

[Regardless of the order, one comment from that episode will be revealed at random.]

> —The Demon King of Salvation! The Demon King of Salvation! The Demon King of Salvation!

I saved the person who wrote the comment as a fan of the 'Demon King of Salvation' and checked the next comment.

> —Zeus, Poseidon, Jecheon Daeseong, and... the Demon King of salvation.

Is he also a fan of the ' Demon King of Salvation'?

I felt Kim Dokja grinning in my head and wondered what was so funny.

I immediately checked the third comment.

> —That is not the Demon King of Salvation I knew...

"Finally a normal comment."

I don't know who wrote the comment, but he is truly a wise friend.

I thought I had finally hit Kim Dokja, but unexpectedly, his reaction was calm.

—What. Because each person’s idea of 'me' will be different.

'You admit it easily?'

—Me too, my impression of Yoo Joonghyuk was different when I first saw him and when I saw him later.

'Are you talking about Yoo Joonghyuk again?'

—Joonghyuk is soft now, but there are times in the second half where he really seems like a psychopath. Especially when his coins decrease, that child becomes very sensitive...

Certainly, this 'Demon King of Salvation' was cynical.

He looked a lot like Kim Dokja.

An office worker who was afraid to even buy a lunch box from a convenience store. A man who lived a simple life of happiness, whose daily pleasure was to get off work early and read Ways of Survival.

—Still, Joonghyuk is somewhat loyal. From what I've seen, it doesn't seem like there was anything wrong with the 41st round...

He was saved by the story of 'Yoo Joonghyuk' and loved 'Ways of Survival' more than anyone else.

A person who was often selfish and sometimes played mischievous pranks, but still had a shred of warmth towards humans.

—If you take advantage of that and roll well in the 41st round, no matter how bad your situation is…

Kim Dokja does not have a great sense of justice, but he protects those close to him at all costs.

—Are you listening to me?

'Yes. 'I'll look at the last comment.'

I used my last free pass.

> —He's in danger of dying again. At this point, I feel pity. Well, his Constellation is also the Demon King of Salvation...

We were silent at the same time. This was because it was very clear who was in danger of dying.

'What is it? This.'

—Hmm.

Is it related to the seventh scenario?

Yoo Joonghyuk said: 'The end of the 'seventh scenario' will be with Anna Croft.'

That means the final chapter of this scenario is 'Peace Land'.

It means that it will be a kind of national cooperative war...

What happened there?

Kim Dokja, who was thinking deeply about something, asked.

—How much of a difference is there between this point of view and our point of view now?

'It will be almost the same. I think the latest version depicts the near future a little ahead of time.'

—It has the same effect as Anna Croft's short-term future vision. Since you have to guess from the comments, the accuracy of the analysis is somewhat low.

'Yes. Well, that's right.'

—What is the speed of development per episode?

'It's not that fast in my opinion.'

—Then it may not be a crisis related to the scenario.

That is correct.

So what is this crisis?

First of all, I think I avoided being beaten to death by Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Have you felt anything strange since you woke up?

My sponsor seemed to have something to do with it.

'Is there something strange?'

—Suddenly, I thought 'that' would start.

'…Can you please stop using ominous expressions? You just have to tell me exactly.'

—I thought so too when I was an incarnation, but if I say it this way, the probability cost is low.

'Does talking also cost money with Midday Tryst?'

—Do you think it's easy for a Constellation to convey information? I think by now you...

'Yes?'

A swooshing sound was heard in Kim Dokja's voice, as if there were noise, and then a light spark flew out of the smartphone.

['Midday Tryst' was interrupted due to a temporary error.]

I immediately checked my smartphone. I thought the relic was defective, but it didn't seem that way.

"Hello?"

Kim Dokja said nothing. No indirect message was heard.

Has he suddenly been hit with a probability aftermath?

That may be so.

Even if the 'Demon King of Salvation' is not a mythical grade Constellation, it’s still a Constellation.

Worst of all, why would we waste all the probability just by calling their names and refer to them with modifiers?

However, I had a real-time chat with a Constellation.

Even if the relic shared the probability, it would certainly not have been an easy task for Kim Dokja.

Anyway, things got awkward.

It seemed like he was trying to say something important at the end...

While I was thinking about this and that, I entered the tent village.

"Ahjussi?"

There was a girl waiting for me at the entrance.

"Ah."

It was Shin Yoosung.

---

I remember the last time I met Shin Yoosung.

Shin Yoosung, whom I met in the solo dungeon 'Nagak’s Field' and explored the Star Jewel Dungeon together.

「"If you say one word, I will kill them all."」

Shin Yoosung at that time was definitely not the Shin Yoosung of the 41st round.

"It’s been a while. How have you been?"

"Fine!"

I looked at Shin Yoosung, who was shouting brightly, and stared at her secretly. A unique white and bright face. I could tell with just a quick look.

It doesn't feel the same as before.

Just looking at each other made me feel cold.

The golden glow is no longer detectable.

So, is Shin Yoosung’s possession now over?

If it's over, why?

An ominous thought rushed into my mind.

Maybe something bad had happened to <Kim Dokja’s Company>.

"Do you remember what happened in the Star Jewel Dungeon?"

I didn't ask with high hope.

However, I was curious about this child's condition.

If this child was possessed by Shin Yoosung of the 1,864th round, what state was this child in during the possession?

"Of course. I remember everything."

She remembers?

"Do you also remember taming the ancient Nagak?"

"Of course! But…"

Shin Yoosung, who paused for a moment, continued.

"That wasn’t me."

"Yes?"

“No, it was me... I guess I should say it was a slightly different me..."

My heart was beating slowly.

She has memories of being in a state of possession.

"What do you mean?"

Shin Yoosung hesitated for a while and explained, as if she had trouble expressing it.

"Well, do you know a skill called [Taming]?"

"No."

"If I had to express it, ... it feels like this. It seems strange that I, from another world, must have tamed me and moved on, doesn’t it?"

Shin Yoosung, who was twisting her hair with her fingers, glanced at me and lowered her head.

I said, holding the child's small shoulder.

"No. It’s not strange at all."

"Really?"

"Yes. I believe you, Miss Yoosoung."

Shin Yoosung’s eyes shone brightly. Her eyes were not as golden as when the 41st round Shin Yoosung possessed her, but in some ways, her eyes were clearer than before.

Shin Yoosung, who was faintly embarrassed, opened her mouth again.

"Ah, I thought you might believe me. My other self also said that."

"What did she say?"

"I can trust you, ahjussi."

"…"

"And now she said she won't be able to come for a while. So she said I should take good care of you…"

I don't know why Shin Yoosung's possession ended. However, she was worried about me until the last moment when the possession was lifted.

Shin Yoosung looked up at me and asked cautiously.

"Ahjussi? Are you okay?"

"It's okay."

She hurriedly lifted her head and closed her eyes.

Shin Yoosung asked in an innocent voice.

"Ahjussi, but can I ask you one question?"

"Yes. Just ask."

"Who is Kim Dokja?"

Where did this child hear that name?

"Kim Dokja…"

The name rang in my ears and my head became dizzy.

"Ahjussi?"

Shin Yoosung hurriedly caught me as I stumbled.

What is it? Somehow my limbs felt weak.

"Ah, ahjussi! Blood…!"

Shin Yoosung, who hurriedly called me, pointed to my neck. I unconsciously brought my hand to my neck.

When did it happen?

Blood was flowing from a minor wound on my neck.

When I looked closely, I saw that it wasn't blood. The blood on my fingers was breaking into pieces.

A story?

"Get away!"

As soon as I reflexively pushed Shin Yoosung away, sparks started flying from my whole body.

[The <Star Stream> has determined the grade of the story that will be given to you.]

Kim Dokja's words came to mind.

Advice that 'my crisis may not be a scenario'.

「I was in a 'scenario departure area', when I was weak, I killed the 'God of the Other World' with the 'Demon King of Salvation'.」

45 days ago, the accomplishments I had achieved were truly unbelievable.

And now, that achievement was coming back to me as a story.

However, not all 'stories' always bring only beneficial effects to their owners.

[A new story related to you is born!]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' was born!]

Heir of the Eternal Name.

That was the name of my new story.

[The temporary grade of this story is 'semi-mythical level'.]

[The grade of this story may be reevaluated in the future.]

[Your current level cannot handle this story.]

One day, on the 'Island of Reincarnation', Yoo Hoseong, the invincible warrior, said something like that.

Those who cannot control the story will eventually be eaten by the story.

For a moment, I remembered what 49% Kim Dokja was like.

He is an [Avatar] Kim Dokja with 49% of his memory.

51% left paving stones for the happiness of his companions.

Wait a minute, no way.

In the 1,864th round, 49% Kim Dokja suffers from a disease that gradually causes his stories to collapse.

[Your physical condition is extremely unstable.]

[The durability of the body decreases rapidly!]

This was the price I paid for declaring that I would become 'Kim Dokja'.

[Currently, you are an imperfect Kim Dokja.]

[You must acquire additional Kim Dokja Fragments to survive.]

I saw my companions running after spotting me from afar. Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, and even Killer King.

But I couldn't welcome them.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal name' is craving it.]

The story inside me was commanding me.

[If you do not acquire a new 'Kim Dokja Fragment' within 50 minutes, you will die.]

To become the one and only Kim Dokja. To destroy all other Kim Dokjas.

[Time left until death: 49:51]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 686 Episode 23 Fragments of God (1)

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[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' begins its storytelling!]

A strong feeling of a foreign object in my head. In the place where my consciousness should be, there was something—a story—sitting there.

It was ordering me.

「I am the only one」

The moment I heard the first syllable, I got goosebumps. Because I knew what kind of sentence it was.

「who knows the ending of this world.」

The introduction of『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

The sentence I once wrote has now returned to me and become a curse.

It has been done.

「I am the only Kim Dokja.」

The universe opened up before my eyes, and an image of dozens, hundreds, and thousands of meteors scattering all at once came to mind.

「If I can't be Kim Dokja,」

「I would rather Kim Dokja did not exist in this universe.」

Whose wish is that? I didn't know where the sentence came from.

What is certain is that I never wrote it and there is no way Han Sooyoung wrote this sentence.

The fact that this story has this sentence probably means that this story also originates from 'Kim Dokja'.

"Inho-ssi!"

I saw Lee Dansu approaching nearby.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is craving it.]

The 'Thought' that were in the shape of a bracelet soon changed into the damaged bamboo suit of Master Samyeong.

The hand holding the bamboo pole was shaking.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' commands feasting.]

I said, grabbing the wrist holding the bamboo pole with my other hand.

"Shut up."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is glaring at you.]

I declared that I would definitely become Kim Dokja. However, that meant that I would shoulder Kim Dokja's duty, not that I would listen to the unreasonable orders of the story.

"Ahjussi—"

Maybe I, too, changed after meeting Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Even if the world grabs me and shakes me, I will not be swayed by this irrational story.

If I don't control the story, the story will control me.

"You are my story. Listen to me."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is laughing at you.]

I bit my lip as I looked at the readers running towards me.

This story was something I couldn't handle right now.

Kim Dokja's name was too heavy and the person I am now is too me.

I was weak.

"I."

But I swore. I made a promise to Han Sooyoung, who wrote the story.

"I am Kim Dokja."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' controls your right arm.]

As if it couldn't hear me, my right arm began to gain magical power.

The story was controlling my right arm. I guess it's planning to kill and take the readers with my right hand.

"I warned you."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' frowns.]

[The story says that if the successor of the eternal name does not eat another 'Kim Dokja', you will disappear.]

I don't want to survive that way.

I'd rather—

"Oh, ahjussi! No! Ahjussi."

Shin Yoosung seemed to have an ominous premonition and clung to my waist.

"It's okay."

I used [Incite] to change the 'damaged master's bamboo pole' to 'Broken Faith'. The blade was activated with shining light.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is staring at you!]

As if it was trying to control me, the sparks sparked by the story tightened my entire body. I resisted it with all my magical power.

Okay, let's fight.

Either you win or I win.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is astonished.]

I held back my 'Broken Faith' and stabbed the knife straight into my stomach.

---

Even in the distant pain, I did not lose consciousness. This is because if I let go of my consciousness, the story could control my body.

"Did he harm himself?"

"Stories are runnung wild all over his body."

"Please bring me a blood transfusion pack quickly!"

"A blood transfusion is not enough. Use this."

"This—"

"It’s my story."

Voices were heard above the surface of my fragile consciousness.

"Inho-ssi! Inho-ssi! No, why did Inho-ssi become like this!"

Okay?

"Save him right now. If you can't save him, I'll kill you all."

The sound of an explosion was heard intermittently.

"What's the matter? Suddenly—"

"Damn, an emergency scenario has begun!"

"Oh my god. Monsters—"

"There is not much power left here. The main focus of the seventh scenario is the United States."

"Then what should we do!"

"Let’s go to Gwanghwamun."

"But Inho-ssi—"

---

['Midday Tryst' has been restored.]

—Stand up, Youngest.

When I opened my eyes, an excruciating pain came from my lower abdomen.

I exhaled several times, enduring the feeling of my stomach turning.

My mind slowly became clearer.

I felt that the presence of the story that had been controlling me until a moment ago had disappeared.

A sense of liberation slowly bloomed in my heart.

[Your sponsor is looking at you.]

Kim Dokja's voice sounded as if he was dumbfounded in the air.

—Yoo Joonghyuk also doesn’t control the stories in that way.

"This was the only way."

The only way to stop the story.

Although it was a bit unconventional, it was the most powerful action I could take right now.

Considering that the story is quiet, it seems like it was successful anyway.

"What about other readers?"

—They're safe. But did you really have to use that method? You could have just used [Incite].

"Because it might not work."

—After thinking that far, you made a hole in your stomach?

"Now I'm a little bit like Kim Dokja."

—What the hell.

Kim Dokja's voice sounded like he was having fun. I also smiled bitterly.

When I slowly looked around, it seemed like I had been admitted to a ward in a temporary shelter. As I pulled out the IV in my arm, my fingertips trembled ominously. It feels like it will break into pieces if someone touches me.

The status of my being was shaking.

Was this how 49% Kim Dokja felt?

A thumping sound echoed from afar. The sound of a building collapsing. People were screaming and moaning. I walked through the tent of my temporary shelter and looked outside.

People who had been practicing repeatedly until the end were scattered throughout Gwanghwamun along with all kinds of monsters.

I quickly gathered my thoughts and asked.

"What happened?"

—The scenario has begun.

Almost immediately, a message log appeared in my mind.

[A sub-scenario is currently in progress.]

**<Sub Scenario — Monster Invasion>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: A++

> Clear conditions: The Balaur tribe, who have a deep grudge against humans, have invaded the Korean peninsula. Stop the invasion and protect your world.
>
> Timeout: —
>
> Reward: Lesser Dragon Heart, ???
>
> Failure: —

It wasn't the main scenario.

It's probably one of the derivative scenarios of the 'main scenario'.

"If it’s a dragon, what level is it?"

—Minimum 5th grade.

My heart sank.

This is because in the fourth scenario, the memory of almost dying when hunting a '5th grade Poisonous Dragon' came to mind.

But the surprise quickly subsided.

Now that I think about it, it's the 'seventh scenario'.

During the time I was unconscious, my companions must have already faced 'Catastrophe level' monsters several times.

In other words, the current group might be able to handle 5th grade or so.

—There is also a 4th grade one.

"4th grade?"

4th grade was a monster I had never faced before. Even if we say that it is up to 5th grade, 4th grade is on a different level. But.

"Where is Yoo Joonghyuk?"

I remembered Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st round.

A monster with more overwhelming force than in the 3rd round.

Anyone who cleared all of the disaster scenarios while I was away would be able to deal with even a 4th grade species.

However.

"Aaaah! Stop it!"

"Save me! Please help me!"

"Aaaahhh!"

No matter where I looked on the battlefield, I could not see Yoo Joonghyuk.

—That guy was forcibly summoned to the final field of the 'seventh scenario' a little while ago.

"Ah."

Now that I think about it, the hour I promised with Yoo Joonghyuk has already passed.

Fortunately or unfortunately, the faces of the readers were not visible.

Dansu ahjussi, Killer King, Ye Hyunwoo, and Kyung Sein.

Yoo Joonghyuk's colleagues, such as Lee Jihye, Lee Hyunsung, Kim Namwoon and Lee Seolhwa were also nowhere to be seen.

It seemed like everyone had moved to the main scenario area.

"Then the people left here—"

—Only selected incarnations can participate in the main event of the seventh scenario. Those people...

People who were not chosen.

The problem was that it wasn't just one or two.

"Aaaahhh!"

Among them were some faces I recognized. For example, Bang Cheolsoo and the mother and daughter.

"Aaaah! Push on! If it continues like this, it will break through!"

"Dayoung! Stick this way!"

Sergeants Kim and Jung Eunho, who fought with me at Seoul Station, were also seen.

"There! There's a hole over there!"

"I'll take care of it!"

A pair of chopsticks thrown by Jung Eunho caused them to scream and fall down. Behind them, Shin Yoosung was also seen summoning Nagak troops to cover the people.

"Fight! Keep fighting!"

They fell helpless before the fire of the monsters.

However, there were more groups running after their own people. At the center of the group of monsters was a dragon that controlled the monster species.

"You can't let them go to the shelter! Stop them!"

A woman stood in the center of the battlefield, confronting the dragon tribe.

After possessing a character in this world, it was the first member of <Kim Dokja Company> I encountered.

[Incarnation 'Jung Heewon' activates 'Kendo Lv.10'!]

Every time Jung Heewon swung her sword, five or six cherubs died.

I watched Jung Heewon's fight, even forgetting to breathe. Over the past 45 days, I could see how hard she had trained.

One step. The balance of the battlefield seemed to be shaken every time the magic power contained in one trajectory caused a ripple.

Krarar La La Lag!

The panicked 5th grade monster swung its tail and counterattacked, but Jung Heewon's momentum showed no signs of stopping.

In an instant, Jung Heewon climbed up the tail and struck with a sword strike.

A sword equipped with strong magical power.

In less than five seconds, dozens of consecutive strikes pierced the 5th grade species' eyes and forehead.

Ahhh!

As one 5th grade species fell with a roar, the expressions on the incarnations' faces changed.

They got brighter.

"It fell down!"

"We can win! We can win!"

As the morale of the incarnations rose, the monsters hesitated and cried out in fear.

Jung Heewon ran toward the next dragon without hesitation.

What stopped her advance sweeping the battlefield was a monster the size of a 10-story building.

[4th grade monster 'Earth Python'’is roaring!]

Howling, all the incarnations in the area screamed and fell down at once.

Even Jung Heewon stumbled, bleeding from her ears.

But Jung Heewon didn't sit down.

[Madness]

A destructive glow flashed in her pupils. The unique characteristics of the 'Mad Butcher' were protecting her consciousness.

"Everybody wake up."

At the sound of Jung Heewon's voice, people who had been rolling around on the floor stood up as if they were infected with madness.

They were all people who couldn't fight any longer.

I couldn't understand.

Why don't you run away?

There is no penalty for failure in this 'sub-scenario'.

That meant that they could let Gwanghwamun be destroyed without having to fight back.

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk knew that too, so he left here without taking any action.

"No way..."

—That's right.

Before I knew it, people were forming a circle around my temporary shelter.

—They’re protecting you.

I looked closely at the faces of all the remaining people.

Geumho Station, Chungmuro, Seoul Station. Faces that I have passed by at least once somewhere.

"Hey, Inho-ssi!"

A middle-aged man who spotted me exclaimed with joy.

"Everyone, look! The captain—"

Yes. With a sound, the man whose neck had been bitten by the monster fell down.

"Kim ahjussi!" A woman cried.

Before I could say anything, a crowd of people rushed in and covered the two of us. I held 'Broken Faith' in my hands.

Let’s use [Incite].

Let’s incite me to call myself Yoo Joonghyuk. No, Jung Heewon, and Kim Dokja. Anyone is good.

Anything is fine—

[This skill cannot be activated.]

It felt like someone was hitting a gong in my head.

[Your incarnation body is currently unstable.]

[Achieve 'Kim Dokja's fragment' within 5 minutes.]

[If the new 'Kim Dokja Fragment' cannot be acquired, you will die.]

I was dying.

Maybe faster than them.

[Time left until death: 4:49]

The flood of stories has subsided, but the penalty has not disappeared.

Yes.

I wanted to save them, but I couldn't think of a way.

I cannot do it.

Even though the people protecting me are dying before my eyes, there is nothing I can do.

—Yoo Joonghyuk made you his colleague.

My constellation's voice came to my ear.

—And yet he left you behind. Why did he do that?

I slowly raised my head.

The reason Yoo Joonghyuk left me here.

"Did he think I could solve this scenario?"

Kim Dokja did not answer.

As my emotions slowly subsided, I could see the situation clearly.

There is no Yoo Joonghyuk.

People are dying.

[Time left until death: 3:08]

I have 3 minutes left to live.

To activate a skill. I had to remove the penalty for this story first.

「Only me」

A penalty that only disappears if I eat 'Kim Dokja'.

Then, there was only one way to tell this story.

"Heir of the Eternal Name."

Giving Kim Dokja, the only person in this world who I can use as 'fodder' for my story.

I raised my right arm to my mouth and ordered the story.

"Eat 'me'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 687 Episode 23 Fragments of God (2)

If I really am the reincarnation of 49% Kim Dokja, and therefore have a fragment of Kim Dokja, then there is no way this method would be impossible.

「It feeds me and runs the story.」

If what you want to eat is 'Kim Dokja', I'll eat it as much as you want.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is looking at you intently.]

Kim Dokja’s voice rang in my head.

—Hey! Wait for a second!

I pretended not to hear him and bit my forearm as hard as I could. I wasn't sure if my actions would lead to predation on stories. But...

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is interested in your story fragment.]

A kind of showmanship to lure the guy.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' bites off your right arm!]

Tsutsutsutsu!

I felt something like fangs biting into my forearm muscle and a terrible pain.

The blood that spurted into the air soon became sharp pain.

I smiled even through the pain.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' feasts on a part of your story!]

As I blinked, the scenery of the snowy field filled my vision.

I don't want to forget anything.

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is nauseated!]

Huh?

—Is it like this?

I heard Kim Dokja click his tongue in my head.

As if he had foreseen this situation.

The Heir to the Eternal Name who ate my story is in pain.

I was crying.

[The fragment crazy soldier Yoo Joonghyuk refuses to be absorbed!]

[The fragment of the story crazy soldier Yoo Joonghyuk goes on a rampage!]

Crazy soldier?

No, why do I have this fragment?

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is staring at you!]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' has absorbed the wrong fables.]

[The corresponding 'Story Fragments' cannot be eaten normally.]

[Incomplete predation will result in 10 minutes of extra time!]

[Time remaining until death: 12:59]

Anyway, I bought some time.

[Skill seal penalty is lifted.]

Plus, the penalty is lifted.

I immediately activated 'Blade of Faith' and lightly cut down a few of the attacking creatures.

I heard someone buried in a pile of monsters crying.

Removing the mountains of their corpses, I could see one human hand sticking out.

"Catch it!"

I held her hand and pulled her out with all my might, and the woman was dragged out, shedding tears.

She was crying while holding the dead uncle.

"Go inside, I will block this place."

"But—"

"Hurry!"

The woman quickly nodded her head and ran into the living room.

I piled up the monsters' corpses to block the entrance to the shelter and then turned around.

In the distance, the battle was still in full swing.

A group led by Bang Cheolsoo and the mother and daughter was continuing the melee nearby, and on the front lines, the siblings Jung Heewon and Jung Eunho were dealing with the dragons together.

—One 5th grade and one 4th grade. Can you do it?

"What does a guy who has been lying down for 45 days do?"

Most incarnations now have as high a level of overall ability as me.

There was no way the situation would change just because I jumped in.

Just hearing the howling of the dragon clan roaring from afar makes my stomach tingle.

In my current physical condition, it would be difficult for me to break through the crowd and enter the front lines.

"Please help me."

—You’re shameless, you bastard.

"Now you have to act like a Constellation."

Even if he is not Mythical grade, the 'Demon King of Salvation' is a Narrative grade one.

A Constellation with the highest rank among its class.

"Please give me some coins. Let me increase my stats."

—Where are my coins?

"Why does my Constellation not have any coins?"

—If there was such a thing, would you have made a collect call?

Come to think of it, this person was a collect call from the first contact.

I thought it was just because he was a salty idiot, but he really did it because he had no money?

"You had a lot of coins when you were an incarnation, right?"

—Because of you, I spent everything, I don’t even have a few pennies left. Did you forget?

There was a scene that came to mind later.

When I first signed a contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation', I borrowed his story, 'The King of a Kingless World'. Did he pay the probability cost with coins at that time?

"But you only lent me one story..."

—It was my birth story, right?

"Anyway, so you don’t have any coins?"

—I said there isn’t any.

I feel like I want to use [Lie Detection].

"Then what can you do?"

—Well...

Suddenly this thought occurred to me.

What are the advantages of becoming Kim Dokja's incarnation?

If you think about it, didn't Shin Yoosung, who was the incarnation of Kim Dokja in the main story, grow up on her own without much support?

—Cheering?

I blew off the head of a Groll, who was running at me, without a word.

—Hey, you Don’t kill him like that.

"Please don’t talk to me because it will disturb me."

—If you look closely, isn’t there something like an incision on the neck? If you stab it and kill it, you can catch it without much effort. Joonghyuk only realized this after the 40th round…

I stabbed one in the neck as it inadvertently ran towards me.

But did I accidentally stab it in the spot Kim Dokja mentioned?

The groll just went limp without even putting in much effort.

"What about the incision line?"

—There, look carefully! A little further inside!

When I squinted and looked closely, I saw that there were faint incisions on each of the grolls’ necks. When the force was adjusted and the shot was fired in a precise trajectory, the group was killed in an instant.

Two, three, four...

After killing as many as sixty in less than a minute. The number of nearby groups has decreased significantly.

—How is it?

It's more helpful than I thought.

As expected, knowing 'Ways of Survival' is different.

As they were quickly cleared from the rear, the fierce struggle continued.

The Geumho Station group also seemed to be taking a breather.

"Hyung!"

Bang Cheolsoo found me and waved his hand.

Fortunately, the damage to the Geumho Station Group was not significant yet.

The problem is what to do with those dragons that occupy the center of Gwanghwamun.

[4th grade Earth Dragon species 'Earth Python' roars!]

The people's complexions turned pale as they heard the roar again.

"Everyone cover your ears!"

With Shin Yoosung's sharp shout, the small Nagak ensemble began at the front.

As the dozen or so Nagak troops poured out their ensemble at once, some of the howling directed at the incarnations was cancelled out.

Some Nagaks created a barrier with their shells to block the attack.

However, the small Nagaks are only 8th grade marine species. In the end, the shells that could not endure it burst into pieces.

Shin Yoosung, who was hiding in one of the shells, stumbled and fell.

"Yoosoung-ssi!"

I hurriedly ran over and hugged Shin Yoosung. When I checked her pulse, I found that her magic circuit was already completely damaged.

I left the fainted Shin Yoosung in the care of Bang Cheolsoo.

"Hyung?"

Bang Cheolsoo, who accepted Shin Yoosung with a dumb expression, looked at me.

In the past, I would have never entrusted Shin Yoosung to this guy.

['Geumho Station Group' unites around the incarnation 'Bang Cheolsoo'.]

But it's different now.

You can tell just by looking at the people at Geumho Station that they still follow him.

"Bang Cheolsoo. No matter what happens, protect her."

"Oh, it’s dangerous to go forward! Let’s run away! While Heewon takes time—"

"Bang Cheolsoo."

Bang Cheolsoo looked at me with trembling eyes and nodded his head with difficulty.

"Yes, I understand."

"It’s a request."

I started running straight to the front line where Jung Heewon was.

There are now 6 minutes left.

Sergeant Kim, carrying the exhausted Jung Eunho, was running away in a huff.

"Inho-ssi! You must not come this way!"

Now, the only one guarding the front line was Jung Heewon.

Jung Heewon continued to fight against the 4th grade earth dragon species and the 5th grade gold dragon species.

As she activated [Demon Slayer] and [Madness] at the same time, her entire body was filled with incredible energy.

It was like watching Yoo Joonghyuk.

But it was clear to anyone that that situation would not last long.

Blood was flowing continuously from her nose and ears.

The dragon tribe also did not take active action, perhaps because they noticed Jung Heewon's condition.

I asked as I slaughtered the monsters blocking the path one by one.

'Do you know the weaknesses of the dragons?'

—I know, but. It's hard to deal with them for you right now with your overall abilities.

'All I have to do is to have high overall stats.'

—Do you have any coins?

I don't know anything else, but there is one thing I am more confident about than other incarnations.

[Coins held: 418,000C]

This time, even Kim Dokja looked surprised.

—What, did you cheat a Constellation?

'I did defeat a demon lord.'

Apparently, the 300,000 coins I received from Asmodeus at the theater were big.

That bastard. He probably didn't know that his own money would be put to such good use.

—Then it's time to sell the full profit.

'It’s been a while since I heard that line.'

I opened my wallet without hesitation.

[You invested 24,000 coins in strength.]

[Strength Lv.40 -> Strength Lv.70]

[Your power has attracted the attention of the giants.]

Muscular strength.

[You invested 24,000 coins in stamina.]

[Stamina Lv.40 -> Stamina Lv.70]

[Your physical strength stimulates the curiosity of the heroes.]

Durability.

[You invested 24,000 coins in agility.]

[Agility Lv.40 -> Agility Lv.70]

[The Miao people are amazed at your agility.]

Agility.

[You invested 24,000 coins in magic power.]

[Magic Lv.40 -> Magic Lv.70]

[Your talent has begun to attract the attention of the Magic Tower.]

And even magic power.

[Your overall abilities have almost reached the limit for this scenario.]

As I instantly raised all my abilities to the limit, my whole body began to overflow with vitality.

Even though I was destined to die in 6 minutes, I wasn't afraid at all.

Was I influenced by Kim Dokja?

—Then it looks like we are ready to return to broadcasting.

'Return to broadcast?'

Now that I think about it, I have barely heard any broadcast messages from the moment I woke up.

It was natural.

I signed a sponsorship contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation' and terminated the exclusive contract with Bihyung.

Although I didn't suffer any significant penalty due to Bihyung's consideration, I was no longer of interest to the Constellations of the 'Finding Incarnations' group.

This means that I have lost my marketability to the Constellations.

—If you spend money, you have to earn back the amount you spent.

I said while dodging the magic wave of the flying Earth Dragon species.

'Now that's a bit difficult. Moreover, my contract with Bihyung has ended—'

—I know. You can do it again.

What am I doing again?

In the first place, the contract between me and Bihyung was possible because I had no sponsor. In the current situation, there was no reason for Bihyung to agree to renew his contract.

It was then that a light spark appeared in the air and a Dokkaebi appeared.

[Now, it’s been a while since we’re broadcasting from the Korean Peninsula, Constellations!]

Indeed, even Dokkaebis will come if you tell them what to do.

Bihyung, who was two times bigger than before, was talking to the Constellations, showing off his white and plump belly.

[A few Constellations say that the Korean Peninsula channel is no longer interesting.]

[A very small number of Constellations are asking whether there are no usable incarnations on the Korean Peninsula channel anymore.]

It was true.

The Korean Peninsula is already in its seventh scenario.

All the incarnations that are strong enough have already signed a sponsorship contract.

But in the midst of all this, there was one idiot who was promoting his own incarnation.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' calls out for you to come see his incarnation!]

It was my cabbage sponsor.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' wonders why no one sees this interesting story.]

I felt a strange sense of déjà vu.

Could it be that Han Sooyoung, who wrote 'Ways of Survival', felt the same way?

'Hey, Kim Dokja-ssi. There's no need to go that far—'

[A very small number of Constellations are annoyed, asking why they should look at other people's incarnations.]

[Very few Constellations say that their good incarnation was lost to that idiot.]

[A very small number of Constellations show hostility to the 'Demon King of Salvation'!]

I didn't want to see my sponsor being criticized anymore.

'As expected, it would be better for you to quit—'

But Kim Dokja's words continued.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' says that incarnation 'Cheon Inho' is not his incarnation, even though it is his incarnation.]

…?

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' declares that the contract he made with his incarnation 'Cheon Inho' is 'temporary'.]

What does that mean?

I pricked up my ears to understand Kim Dokja's nonsense.

[The incarnation 'Demon King of Salvation' declares that incarnation 'Cheon Inho' will be trained harshly for the next two years and then sent back to the sponsorship contract market!]

[A very small number of Constellations are glaring at you, asking how they can believe such a lie.]

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' swears to the <Star Stream>.]

It was absurd.

I wanted to ask what would happen if I took that kind of oath on my own.

But

coo coo coo coo—

Lightning struck in the air.

The sky over the Korean Peninsula was turning red as if a 'Great Hall' had opened.

The light emitted by the Constellations temporarily changed the color of the sky.

[Multiple Constellations have entered the channel!]

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' asks if he has finally awakened.]

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' picks his ears, saying he has been bored.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' grumbles that the Korean Peninsula channel is still small.]

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' congratulates you on your return.]

[The Constellation 'Queen of the Darkest Spring' is interested in the 'Demon King of Salvation'’s words.]

[The Constellation 'God of Wine and Ecstasy' asks how much he will be sold for in two years.]

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' sheds tears, saying it has been a while.]

I wondered what on earth was happening. The incarnations and even the dragons were startled and stopped moving.

But that wasn't the end.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' has signed a 'stream contract' with the Dokkaebi 'Bihyung'.]

What on earth have you done to already renew my contract?

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' has modified the terms of contract conditions.]

Contract conditions.

Belatedly, I remembered the details of the contract I had signed.

'Bihyung' in this round is a formidable guy. He agreed to a donation distribution ratio of 7 to 3.

Since this is a contract renewal, these conditions are bound to become more unfavorable —

[The donation distribution conditions have been modified to 10 to 0.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 688 Episode 23 Fragments of God (3)

My open mouth could not be closed.

10 to 0?

Really? You won a 10-0 contract against that Bihyung?

When I looked up into the sky, I saw Bihyung sweating with a troubled expression on his face. It felt like he was having a conversation with someone, but it was obvious who it was.

—The conversation is over. Of course you know we are 10, right?

A hollow laugh came out.

Right.

Kim Dokja was this kind of person.

'What on earth have you done?'

He placed me in the center of the battlefield, opened the Seoul Broadcasting channel, renewed the <Stream Contract>, and invited Constellations to this channel.

[A significant number of Constellations are watching your movements!]

[300 coins were sponsored.]

All of this happened in less than 5 minutes.

—Are you ready?

I realize once again who I signed with.

He was once the swindler of this <Star Stream>.

The devil who mocked, despised, and saved the Constellations.

"Yes."

I have 5 minutes left to live.

Again, I wasn't afraid.

Now I know why I am not afraid.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' is with you.]

Perhaps I have been waiting for this moment all along.

—Let’s begin the return stage.

As I ran with all my might, my 70-strong strength condensed and my acceleration increased.

[The story 'persistent martial arts master' begins its storytelling.]

As the story of the Ark was wrapped in my hands, my magic power, which had matured even further, drew blue in the air.

The monsters' heads were blown away like toys in a straight trajectory.

[The Constellation 'Goryeo’s First Sword' nods to your martial arts.]

Somehow, I felt like I was more accustomed to dealing with stories than before.

Is this also the influence of my sponsor?

Oooooh!

In the distance, an angry dragon howled and let out a bright red breath.

[5th grade monster dragon species, 'Variant Imoogi Bracky' prepares 'breath'!]

It was a monster species that did not appear in the main story.

—It’s literally just an Imoogi. Strictly speaking, it's not a proper 'dragon'.

But I have Kim Dokja.

—The breath pattern is vertical. Looking at the pattern on its back, it appears to be a lower class of the Fire Dragon and Earth Dragon. Maybe there are rocks mixed in between the breaths?

[5th grade monster dragon species 'Variant Imoogi Bracky' uses 'breath'!]

In fact, large chunks of hail were mixed in between the flying breaths.

While watching the flying fireball, Kim Dokja calmly continued his explanation.

—The flames are clustered around the boulder, so you only need to dodge the big ones. Open your eyes straight, have you ever played a rhythm game?

'I know what you want to say.'

—Think you're in the game now.

It was nonsense, but I actually did it.

I bent down just in time for the hailstones to fly in, and I swung my [Unbreakable Faith] to blow up the small lumps that I was unable to avoid. Even though the heat exploded right in front of me, I didn’t look away.

I thought I could do it.

—Okay, next!

The moment I kicked off the floor at the signal and flew up, my eyes met in the air with Jung Heewon’s, who was dodging the breath.

"Inho-ssi?"

Before Jung Heewon, who was surprised to see me, could shout out anything, I pointed behind her.

"Heewon-ssi! Behind you!"

The tail of the 4th grade dragon, who was looking for an opening, flew straight towards Jung Heewon. It was an attack with no apparent angle to avoid.

—Don't worry.

At the same time as Kim Dokja's words, a dazzling aura rose from Jung Heewon's whole body.

[Incarnation 'Jung Heewon' activates 'Judgment Time'!]

A super-powerful skill that demonstrates omnipotent combat power against monsters.

「Judgment Time, which only the 'Judge of Destruction' can use, has demonstrated its supernormal ability.」

"Hold on tight!"

Jung Heewon, who snatched my hand, made abnormal movements in the air and fell to the ground.

As the monster's tail narrowly passed by, Jung Heewon sighed and shouted while holding onto my wrist.

"When did you wake up… No, rather, why did you come here! Do you know what the situation is now—"

"We'll talk about that later. Heewon-ssi, if it were the current Heewon-ssi…"

I continued speaking as I caught a glimpse of the 4th grade dragon, who was glaring at us after retracting his tail.

"Can you deal with that guy?"

Even if Kim Dokja was with me, it was impossible to hunt a 4th grade monster with my current specs.

But for Jung Heewon, the story is different.

She is a specialist in hunting big monsters.

Now that [Judgment Time] has been activated, I might be able to fight against a 4th grade monster species.

"With that one thing, there's no chance of winning."

"The other thing is the problem."

I said while looking at the 5th grade monster running towards me.

"I will deal with the 5th grade. Heewon-ssi, please hold back the 4th grade."

"Wait a minute, you're so arrogant—"

"Heewon-ssi, you know very well what's more important right now. If we don't catch those monsters, everyone here will die."

At my words, Jung Heewon hurriedly looked behind her.

Sergeant Kim retreated to the rear with Jung Eunho on his back. Bang Cheolsoo's group was also seen protecting him.

Jung Heewon, frowning, let go of my wrist and said.

"I have a lot of questions to ask later."

She ran straight towards the 4th grade monster. An Earth Dragon also swung its huge front paws at her as if it had been waiting.

Immediately afterwards, a deafening roar erupted. If she were a normal incarnation, it would have been a blow that would have crushed her to the ground.

But Jung Heewon endured.

Oooooh!

Body specifications increased significantly while passing through the seventh scenario. Plus the buffs of [Judgment Time] and [Demon Slaying].

If she was like that now, she wouldn't be defeated even if her opponent was Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round.

I called out to Kim Dokja in my mind.

'Hey, Kim Dokja-ssi.'

I know it's a fight so exciting that he won't be able to take his eyes off it, but he still has to do what he has to do.

—Oh sorry. It reminds me of the old days.

Old days.

It wasn't that difficult to think of what Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation', might have thought while looking at Jung Heewon.

'But now I have just three minutes left to live.'

—Don't worry. You won't die here.

'Do you really have to speak so ominously?'

The 5th grade dragon species that had prepared its attack rushed towards me once again.

If it was 5th grade, it was a level that couldn’t have been killed even if the readers and I launched a joint attack 45 days ago.

I used the 'Labyrinth Watcher' to buy time, and I was able to hunt the monster only after Dansu ahjussi died once and I also risked my life.

Would I be able to kill such a monster alone?

—Strictly speaking, it’s not a major character. At least it can't use techniques like 'total annihilation'. That's because it only activates in disaster scenarios.

'Even if there's no such thing as annihilation, it doesn’t change that it’s strong.'

—You said your specs are enough for now? There's no time, so let's go quickly.

I nodded.

I had a clear idea in my head of what to do even if no one told me to.

—Sylphide's Leaping Boots.

[The special option 'Leap' is activated.]

I soared up the body of the dragon in one go.

—Now.

When I activated the 'Blade of Faith' through 'Thought', the sword strike, which became even sharper due to the acceleration of [Leap], pierced the guy's spine.

The sensation of the blade entering was definitely different from the fourth scenario.

I guess it's because my physical stats have improved significantly.

Ahhh!

But this one blow wasn't enough to take him down.

A more certain shot was needed.

—Use [Incite] and [Sentence Enhancement].

A combination of [Sentence Enhancement] and [Incite] that reinforce behavior. It was one of my few talents that [incited] me to become a specific character and used that character's power.

'Can I use Yoo Joonghyuk?'

—How do you imitate Yoo Joonghyuk at your level now?

'There have been times when I did it.'

It was true.

It was short-lived and didn't go very well.

—The opponent is a monster species that evolved from an Imoogi. It’s obvious who to imitate, right?

'Ah.'

I nodded.

Now it’s the seventh scenario.

The number of stories I have is three.

Considering that one of them was 'semi-mythical', there was a character who I could have attempted to incite as even at my level.

Even more so if that guy's body is an Imoogi.

Ahhh!

The tip of its sharp claws scratched my thigh.

I suppressed the pain and activated [Sentence Enhancement].

[The sub-skill 'Sentence Enhancement' is activated!]

[You can enter your actions.]

[The actions you enter will be reinforced.]

…

[An error occurred!]

[Currently you cannot activate 'Sentence Enhancement'!]

[All probabilities needed to strengthen sentences have been exhausted!]

I belatedly remembered the last time I activated the skill.

At that time, I had wasted all probability in signing a contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation' to kill the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

'I think I'm screwed.'

—It’s okay. You can at least use [Incite]!

'[Incite] cannot even imitate the character's skills.'

—It doesn’t matter, trust me! Hurry!

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated!]

"I am-"

In my head, the pages of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint began to turn.

He is a being who can easily subdue the Imoogi in front of me.

The Constellation that defeated Yamata no Orochi in the 'sixth scenario' in Peace Land.

"I am Kim Dokja, who defeated the 'Eight-Headed Snake' in 'Peace Land'!"

['Incite' is pushed to its limit!]

With the activation of [Incite], strong faith surged deep into my cells.

“I am Kim Dokja. I am the same Kim Dokja who hunted Yamata no Orochi."

Then, the dragon species in front of me actually looked like nothing.

That's right, I hunted Yamata no Orochi.

What's so scary about that 5th grade?

I swung my sword at it with overflowing confidence.

I can win. I can kill—

Kagaga!

'Blade of Faith' was easily blocked.

The guy's huge maw opened before my eyes.

Quaaaaa!

I screamed as I hurriedly dodged the pouring breath.

If I had just been hit by that, I would have died.

I would’ve been really dead.

—Are you crazy? What are you doing rushing in just like that?

'No, you said to believe it!'

—There’s no way you can win with just [Incite]! Give me 20,000 coins quickly.

'Yes—no, how much?'

Kim Dokja had no answer. And.

[Sponsor contract provisions is activated!]

[Your Constellation is extorting a portion of the donation amount scheduled for you.]

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' acquired 20,000 coins.]

No, this guy.

Kim Dokja opened his mouth as if satisfied.

—Good. Let's get started.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' uses 20,000 coins.]

At that moment, I realized what Kim Dokja was trying to do.

He has now paid the directing fee.

20,000 coins is the minimum probability to put my 'fake acting' on the 'real stage'.

[The story 'The One who Hunted the King of Disasters' begins its storytelling.]

The One who Hunted the King of Disasters.

Kim Dokja's legendary story, a story obtained by cutting down Yamata no Orochi, who possesses the power of an Outer God.

That story was embedded in my whole body.

[「Staging」 begins.]

The stage before my eyes began to change according to the influence of the story.

A part of Gwanghwamun's scenery was momentarily transformed into 'Veronica Castle', which was the stage of 'Peace Land'.

[Currently, the reproduction level of 'Staging' is low.]

Although the level of reproduction was low because the opponent was not 'Yamata no Orochi', this was enough for now.

Grrrr—!

As evidence, the momentum of 5th grade dragon species had clearly changed. Unlike before, its eyes showed a strange sense of fear.

It was natural.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is surprised by your story!]

This story is a story of the murder of the 'King of Imoogis'.

[The Constellations of the Balaur lineage are doubting the probability of the 'Demon King of Salvation'!]

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire''s eyes shine at your performance.]

I ran out as if I were Kim Dokja from 'Peace Land'.

A 5th grade dragon species opened its vicious maw as if it was about to bite me.

—Jump in!

With Kim Dokja's signal, I performed the mimicry of [Leap] and 'Thought' at the same time.

'Change into the Everchanging Stealth suit.'

[The effect of the 'Everchanging Stealth Suit' is activated!]

Just like when I entered the 'Star Jewel Dungeon', I used the 'Everchanging Stealth Suit' to reduce the size of my body.

The moment the panicked monster dragon species opened its mouth, I burst into its mouth like a small shooting star. As soon as I passed through the uvula and into the esophagus, Kim Dokja gave a signal.

—Now.

I took off my stealth suit and put my hand into my chest. There was a real 'Unbreakable Faith' left behind by Han Sooyoung, who disappeared there.

'Help me, Han Sooyoung.'

I held the handle of the sword as if praying.

It's impossible on my own.

I also came here because of the story you wrote.

[The story 'The One who Hunted the King of Disasters' roars!]

Shamelessly, I needed the power of that story one more time.

Giiiiiiing!

Light exploded from 'Unbreakable Faith' and a powerful 'Blade of Faith' emerged.

The characteristic of [Circulatory Retardation] was activated and magical power was released like a waterfall.

Stronger, faster.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' nods his head.]

I can't be Kim Dokja, who killed the King of Disasters—but if I have the qualifications to be 'Kim Dokja' at all.

If only I was still allowed that name.

「At that moment, I will not doubt that I am Kim Dokja.」

The deep blue, white-blue magical power drew a dazzling trajectory.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 689 Episode 23 Fragments of God (4)

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A huge amount of magical power was flowing out through my right hand, and a bright light appeared above my head.

Dizziness that comes with a feeling of exhaustion.

I could feel the gaze of stars in the sky.

The severed head of the 5th grade dragon species was looking up at me in disbelief.

[You have defeated the 5th grade dragon species mutant Imoogi Bracky!]

…

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' is astonished by your action!]

[The Constellation 'Goryeo’s First Sword' praises your courage.]

[The Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' gives a thumbs up, saying he is also a descendant of the Korean Peninsula.]

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is interested in your fighting style.]

[Some Constellations are interested in the proposal of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

[A total of 5,000 coins were sponsored!]

From afar, I could see Bang Cheolsoo and the people of Geumho Station cheering in this direction.

[30 seconds left until death.]

It occurred to me that dying like this wasn't that bad.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor increases.]

[The possibility of a new story germinates.]

—Youngest.

'Yes.'

—You don’t really want to die, do you?

'There are now 20 seconds left.'

Is there any way to survive right now?

Honestly, I don't know.

Should I once again feed myself to the 'Heir of the Eternal Name'?

Will that method work this time too?

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' refuses to prey on you.]

It doesn't work either.

Then there is no way for me.

Now I only trust Kim Dokja.

—Let’s see. It should be somewhere around here... Uh, over there! The head!

'The head?'

—Falling head! Hurry!

When I looked closely, I saw that items had fallen between the monster’s head that had fallen on the floor.

One was the 'core of a 5th grade monster dragon species', and the other was...

"This…"

I was startled and picked up the item that had fallen on the floor.

To be precise, it wasn't an 'item'. It is a fragment that looks like a crude collection of very small letters.

[Fragment of the story 'For a reader, a reader’s life' has been acquired.]

Why on earth does the dragon have this?

—Phew, it was there as expected.

No, why is this—

—Just feed it quickly. If you're being foolish, you'll really be in trouble.

'Do you want me to feed it this?'

—That’s also 'Kim Dokja’s fragment'.

Just by looking at the name, it was clear that it was a fragment of Kim Dokja.

[5 seconds left until death.]

I really don't have time anymore.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is interested in the story fragment you have acquired!]

'Want some?'

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' opens its mouth greedily.]

Immediately, a sound like biting into a piece of soft meat was heard, and smoke rose from the palm of my hand.

[The time limit has elapsed.]

Was it successful?

Can I keep living?

A series of sentences flowed through my mind as if answering my questions.

「"It's okay, Yoo Sangah."

"Yes?"

"Even if you tell me about the app, it won't help."

The genre of my life now is clearly 'realism'.

"Because readers have their own lives."

And in this genre, I am not the protagonist but the 'reader'.」

This scene seems to be a fragment of the story, 'For a reader, a reader's life'.

Eventually, the sound of the tale burping lightly after finishing its feast was heard.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' succeeded in predation.]

[The status of the story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' has slightly increased.]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is somewhat satisfied.]

[1 day time limit has been added.]

1 day!

My life expectancy increased by a whopping day.

—Look at that. I said you wouldn't die here, right?

I was dumbfounded and looked up into the air.

How did Kim Dokja know that this dragon species had 'Kim Dokja's fragment'?

"Is it possible that this dragon species also appears in Ways of Survival?"

—It does come out, but not like this. No matter what events exist within 'Ways of Survival', this monster cannot be here.

The monster in front of me is a 'dragon species that should not be here right now'.

—However, in this '41st round', an incident occurred that did not appear in any episode of 'Ways of Survival'.

I immediately understood what Kim Dokja said.

In this world, there was only one incident that had nothing to do with 'Ways of Survival'.

Me and the existence of other readers who have read 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint'.

I looked down at the dead monster's head and muttered.

"No way…"

Perhaps this monster has eaten and erased 'readers' that I do not know.

If it has evolved beyond its original level through the fragments obtained in that way.

If that's the case, how many fragments of readers exist in this world? And in the process, how many readers...

—Now, let’s not think about the complicated stuff. It could just be a fragment that fell on the road and was picked up by chance.

'There's no way something like this is just lying on the street.'

—Well, it's a shame.

From a distance, the 4th grade monster could be seen fighting to the death with Jung Heewon.

—That guy over there has a 'large fragment'.

'Really?'

—I’m sure. I can feel it now.

A larger fragment.

In other words, if I deal with that guy, I can live longer.

[4th grade Earth Dragon species 'Earth Python' activates 'Annihilation Footprints'!]

The entire area shook violently, and a huge seismic wave was generated centered around the guy's feet. Bright red lava overflowed through the cracks in the cracked ground.

As I soared into the air using [Leap], the bloody battle between Jung Heewon and the 4th grade Earth Dragon species was visible at a glance through the clouds of dust and steam.

Jung Heewon injured her thigh and shoulder.

However, the Earth Dragon species also had both wings cut off and one ankle was seriously injured, so it seemed difficult to move.

Strong magical power trembled from Jung Heewon's blade as if trying to determine a match.

Ether Blade.

The blade of pure magical power created through persistent training stretched out, and in an instant, Jung Heewon's divine form disappeared.

[Incarnation 'Jung Heewon' activates 'Kendo Lv.10'!]

Jung Heewon, who appeared from the sky, drew a horizontal trajectory toward the monster's neck.

Even if it is 4th grade, it is an unavoidable blow with injuries like that.

It was the unstoppable victory of Jung Heewon.

However.

—Of course, it’s not an ordinary 4th grade monster.

With a sound like a swoosh, the incarnation of the 4th grade Earth Dragon species dispersed like smoke.

Jung Heewon made an embarrassed expression.

Before I could warn her, the Earth Dragon species that took over Jung Heewon's rear struck her with its huge tail.

Bang—

With a sound, Jeong Heewon plummeted to the ground.

The clever Earth Dragon left his last move until the last moment.

"Heewon-ssi!"

I repeatedly [Leaped] with all my might and held Jung Heewon as she fell to the ground. Dark red blood leaked out from Jung Heewon's mouth.

"Heewon-ssi! Come to your senses!"

She still seems to have not lost her fighting spirit as the aura of [Judgement Time] and [Demon Slaying] flowed out of her body.

But I could tell just by feeling her pulse.

Jung Heewon was no longer in a state to fight.

I looked back at the rear battle line, which had been sorted out to some extent.

Fortunately, there is no penalty for running away in this scenario.

She needs to run away now.

When it is difficult for the 4th grade Earth Dragon species to move, we should run away as soon as possible—

—No. Catch that guy.

Those were Kim Dokja's words.

—You don't know when you'll find fragments again. The only chance is now.

I know. That now is an opportunity.

But can I do it?

Will I be able to kill that guy who even Jung Heewon couldn't defeat?

—There is a chance of victory. [Staging] is not finished yet.

As the hazy dust cleared, the brilliant eyes of the 4th grade Earth Dragon species were revealed.

Kim Dokja was right.

A faint fear reflected in its eyes.

It’s afraid of me now.

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' is watching your courage.]

—Fight to the death, Youngest. If you want to become the real 'Kim Dokja' you want to be.

At that moment, I saw Bang Cheolsoo and Dayoung's mother running from behind.

"Hyung! Heewon-ssi!"

Instead of Bang Cheolsoo, who was carrying Shin Yoosung, I looked at Dayoung’s mother.

"Please take care of Heewon-ssi."

Dayoung’s mother didn’t hesitate and carried Jung Heewon.

Jung Heewon, who seemed to be still conscious, opened her eyes wide.

I smiled lightly at Jung Heewon and then spoke to my companions.

"From now on, do your best to leave Gwanghwamun."

"Hyung! You too should leave with us—"

"Bang Cheolsoo. I can save myself somehow. Protect the people who trust you first."

Bang Cheolsoo, his eyes red, eventually lowered his head. He also knows that there is no way.

"Withdraw! Everyone, withdraw!"

After Bang Cheolsoo and Dayoung's mother ran away, I looked back at the Earth Dragon.

He too was looking this way, growling as if he was ready for a decisive battle.

[The time limit for 'Staging' is approaching.]

[The power of 'staging' weakens.]

It is difficult.

We can't end the stage already.

"I am-"

As I was preparing for [Incite] once again, I heard Kim Dokja's words.

—Reproducing the same scene continuously is not effective.

I knew. The stage once recreated through「Staging」 does not have the same level of impact on the Constellations.

[A very small number of Constellations ask if you are telling the same story again.]

In other words, this time, like before, it was impossible to confront him just by borrowing the power of 'Kim Dokja who hunted Yamata no Orochi'.

'I know.'

But it didn't matter.

Because-

"Because the person I wanted to recreate this time was not 'Kim Dokja'."

Even if the story has the same content, the main character of the story is different.

If it's another person, it's a different story.

The person I will recreate now is—

"I am."

In some ways, that protagonist surpasses even 'Kim Dokja'.

"I am 'Yoo Joonghyuk' who defeated the 'Eight-Headed Monarch' in 'Peaceland'."

As the pages turned in my head, the image of Yoo Joonghyuk and Yamata no Orochi fighting came to mind clearly.

[Fragment of the story 'Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' squirms.]

Accordingly, the unidentified story of Yoo Joonghyuk, who I do not know when I acquired it, began to move within me.

[The story 'The One Who Hunted the King of Disasters' responds to the story fragment 'Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

I thought I could do it.

It’s Yoo Joonghyuk in the moment when he was dealing with Yamata no Orochi.

Goooooooo!

The aura of Yoo Joonghyuk’s mentor, imbued with the power of stories, was carried on the clear, burning trail of Unbreakable Faith.

The Earth Dragon, startled by the subversive force, hesitated and retreated.

This guy.

I leapt in the air, slashing my sword again and again as if struggling. The magic wave that imitated Yoo Joonghyuk's [Stage Transfomasion] grew around 'Unbreakable Faith'.

It wasn't easy. Even if I tried my best, reaching Yoo Joonghyuk felt like a long way off.

—I!

'I am.'

But at least I wasn't the only one shouting these words now.

—I am Yoo Joonghyuk!

'I am Yoo Joonghyuk.'

[The synchronization rate with the Constellation is increasing!]

[The reproduction rate of the story increases slightly!]

The yellow pupils of the Earth Dragon species became vertically elongated.

The guy was truly shocked. He was so overwhelmed by the story that he began to believe the scenery before his eyes rather than the actual damage he would receive.

Eventually, when the guy's fear reached its peak. The frightened monster's new form scattered in the air.

The technique used on Jung Heewon.

[Fog ability.]

—You got caught, you bastard.

[The special option of 'Unbreakable Faith' is activated.]

The fog's weakness is 'elemental attacks'.

[Ether attribute is converted to 'Flame'.]

I used [Nagak Breathing] to hold my breath and spin like a top, swinging the blade of flame. The particles that came into contact with the flames suffered a crushing blow and began to melt.

Woo!

The Earth Dragon species regaining its form crashed to the ground with its half-burnt body.

At the same time, I was like, wow. And I vomited out the things inside me.

Following the overlapping [Incite], it was the price of enduring the story of my sponsor for too long.

[「Staging」 ends.]

The stage ends and the actor leaves.

[The story 'The One Who Hunted the King of Disasters' ends its storytelling.]

I barely raised my head with my hands on the floor. The Earth Dragon species that had collapsed was seen standing up again.

That's it.

The [Fog] ability could no longer be used, but it was still alive and well.

I felt like the atmosphere around me was opening up. He is preparing his final [Breath].

[Fragment of the story 'Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' looks at you pitifully.]

Yoo Joonghyuk’s contempt woke me up.

I didn't fall. I can never die here.

I must protect people.

Jung Heewon, Jung Eunho, Sergeant Kim, and the people who saved me. I must buy time for them to escape.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor is increasing!]

At that moment.

—Good job, Youngest.

A warm feeling began to circulate deep within my heart.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor has reached a certain level.]

[A new 'stigmata' has been acquired.]

The power of my Constellation spread throughout my body.

[The stigma 'Sacrificial Will Lv.1' is activated!]

Finally, Kim Dokja's first stigmata bloomed.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 690 Episode 23 Fragments of God (5)

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[Sacrificial Will.]

Since Kim Dokja had so few stigmata, I knew very well what this stigma was.

'Surely this is a strategy?'

—Okay, just trust me now.

[Breath] is coming right in front of me, so what am I supposed to believe?

'This is just the stigma of sacrificing oneself.'

—Yes.

I could no longer trust the crazy Constellation.

[4th grade Earth Dragon species 'Earth Dragon' shows its hostility toward you.]

Even if we die, let's kill that guy and die.

The one who helped me wake up was again Yoo Joonghyuk's fragment.

I was angry.

[Fragment of the story 'Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' is staring at you.]

I slowly stood up from my seat, holding my 'Unbreakable Faith' I picked up on the floor.

[Understanding of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' increases!]

[Fragment of the story 'Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' is resonating with the skill 'Incite'!]

[The effect of 'Incite' becomes stronger!]

"Kim Dokja, I will kill you."

—Ok?

"Didn’t you tell me to only trust you? Why did the situation become like this?"

My mouth started chattering arbitrarily, and I was overcome with a feeling of unfairness.

—Hey. It’s [Incite]. Untie yourself and come to your senses! You are no longer Yoo Joonghyuk!

Kim Dokja noticed my condition and urgently shouted.

"Kill you! I’ll definitely kill you!"

As if I were Yoo Joonghyuk, I did my best to maintain 'Unbreakable Faith'.

And with the other hand, I activated 'Thought'.

Normally, there would be no good result from [Incite] running rampant like this.

But this time was different.

The moment the breath of the Earth Dragon Species came in front of my nose, 'Thought' glowed brightly and mimicked the 'Shield of Hercules'.

[The special skill 'Wide Area Defense' is activated!]

Wide Area Defense.

However, there was no way that the replica item's special skill could block the 4th Grade Earth Dragon's breath.

Along with the fierce wind pressure, fine fragments were lodged on the surface of the shield.

The shield cracked in an instant and was shattered before it could last even a second.

But when the breath hit, I was no longer there.

—Oh...

"Kill! Kill!"

Unlike my mouth, which foolishly repeated the same words, my body moved nimbly. As if I really was Yoo Joonghyuk who used [Recovery].

[Fragment of the story 'Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' nods.]

My legs, which had pushed my muscles to their limit, were shaking.

When the Earth Dragon species that had missed my new form cried out and changed the direction of its breath, I was already behind it.

"Kill!"

The 'Unbreakable Faith' that poured all its magical power flew through the air.

Ahhh!

The 'Blade of Faith', which spun like a top, hit the monster's feet, and at the same time, a feeling of helplessness flooded through my whole body once again.

['Incite' is lifted.]

Incredible recoil. Now I really couldn't move a finger.

The monster with its feet tied was spitting out its final breath at me.

—Good job. Now it's perfect.

The faint light flowing from my whole body was flowing somewhere. It was the light of [Sacrificial Will].

[Sacrificial Will.]

When the caster risks his life for his comrades. The problem with that skill, which greatly amplifies the attack power of the entire party in proportion to the desperation, was that I had no friends at the moment.

—This skill is the one who can bring even the dead Joonghyuk back to life for a while.

That can't be possible.

No, even if that were the case, Yoo Joonghyuk isn’t here now—

—There is no Yoo Joonghyuk, though.

With those words, an explosion was heard from afar.

A faint thread of light extended from me and led towards the epicenter of that explosion.

—Because that person exists.

Jung Heewon, tears of blood flowing from both eyes, was running towards us.

[Stigmata 'Sacrificial Will Lv.1' is activated to the limit!]

---

Jung Heewon remembers the moment she met that first man.

—I like Jung Heewon.

A person who suddenly smiled strangely at Geumho Station, where the scent of blood was in the air.

—Heewon-ssi... I love you... I'm so sorry...

A person who said strange things.

—There is a character named Jung Heewon in the novel I wrote.

He likes to talk nonsense with a grumpy face.

—She looks very strong on the outside, but in reality, she is a soft person. Because she's such a tough person, she doesn't avoid fights, so she breaks often.

The one who risked his life to save her time and time again.

—I left home when I was in high school. Didn't I tell you?

He was the one who made her talk about her family for the first time.

"Family."

It was throbbing and her head hurt.

—Jung Heewon. Aren’t you curious what the 'original story' was like?

The voice of a woman in a white coat. She had her memories floating around with her.

It was like a 'novel''s story he was talking about.

Jung Heewon in that novel was someone similar to her, but a little different.

—I don't always want to step forward.

A person who is strong on the outside but soft on the inside.

—But since that person keeps jumping forward, there’s nothing I can do. A stronger me must step forward.

A person who had to muster up courage every time and become stronger.

Jung Heewon was curious.

Why did the self in that world have to become so strong?

Did she want to become stronger?

—Don't talk nonsense! I can't stand it! Don't go alone again! Please!

Jung Heewon of that world called a certain name a lot.

—Dokja-ssi!

A name she has never called before.

—Kim Dokja!

Is it family?

Or is it someone she loves?

She doesn't know.

However, Jung Heewon felt like her heart would break when she thought about that name.

Even though she knows this is just a story from a novel.

"Also."

When she thinks of that name.

"I can’t let you die."

She felt angry, sad, and heartbroken.

And she doesn't know why.

['Demon Slaying' runs rampant!]

Right now, Jung Heewon was feeling the same way about that man.

Explosive magical power flowed from her entire body. Munechika Mikazuki, held in her right hand, trembled violently. Her heart rate was abnormally high.

"You can’t die, you can’t die, you can’t die."

Her muscles contracted and expanded repeatedly. With each step, tens of meters of scenery rushed by.

['Madness' is affected by 'Sacrificial Will'!]

[The owner of the skill risked their life for others.]

[The party's attack power increases significantly in proportion to the desperation of life.]

Even as the surging breath completely covered her.

Jung Heewon did not miss the surprised face of this man.

Strangely, the moment she saw him, Jung Heewon felt like she had found something she had been searching for her whole life.

---

I could not come to my senses as the sword fight unfolded before my eyes.

I don’t know if Yoo Joonghyuk is capable of such amazing feats.

Kwa-kwa-kwa-kwa-kwa!

Jung Heewon's sword, which was spinning so fast that it could not be seen, was removing all the breaths of the flying Earth Dragon species.

Oooooh!

The surprised Earth Dragon let out an even more intense breath, but Jung Heewon was not pushed back at all.

Every time Munechika Mikazuki shone bright blue, it was the Earth Dragon who was pushed back.

As Jung Heewon, who was not afraid of death, took a step forward, as if she were a ghost, the Earth Dragon, a 4th grade monster, hesitated and took a step back.

"Heewon-ssi?"

As if she couldn't hear me, Jung Heewon was just repeating the same actions and repeating the same words.

"You can’t die, you can’t die, you can’t die."

I got a little goosebumps.

'Why is she doing this all of a sudden?'

—That...

Kim Dokja hesitated for a moment, as if he had something to point out, and then continued speaking in a shameless tone.

—I don't know either.

The breath of the 4th grade Earth Dragon species stopped suddenly. The moment the pale-faced monster took a deep breath, Jung Heewon's new form disappeared from sight.

Faster than me using [Leap].

The 4th grade Earth Dragon, whose feet were tied by my blow, now had no way to escape.

The monster's claws moved dully, tracing the air, and at the same time, a bloody line appeared on the monster's neck.

Jung Heewon, who sliced the monster's neck in one motion, only glanced at it.

In the blink of an eye, it landed next to me.

Then it fell forward like a doll whose strings had been cut.

[4th grade Earth Dragon species 'Earth Dragon' has been defeated!]

[A wonderful achievement has been achieved!]

[Contributors: Jung Heewon, Cheon Inho]

I quickly helped Jung Heewon up, who had fallen.

"Heewon-ssi!"

At the same time, all kinds of messages started pouring into my head.

[As a reward, you have received a 'Lesser Dragon Heart'!]

[150,000 coins were obtained!]

-

[The Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' sponsors 2,000 coins for your battle.]

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband'… ]

I couldn't help but not smile despite the feast of coins pouring in. This is because Jung Heewon was looking up at me with her eyes wide open.

"Don’t die."

Jung Heewon's hands went limp, as if she had lost her mind.

I looked up into space as I quickly pushed the 'Elain Forest Spirit' into her mouth.

It was only then that I realized what Kim Dokja had done and what stigma his [Sacrificial Will] was.

"You, you really—"

I couldn't bear to continue talking.

—I’m a bad person.

However, Kim Dokja was a person who read what was not said better than anyone else.

Kim Dokja must have known from the beginning.

What happens if you use [Sacrifice Will]. How his colleagues are hurt.

"I-"

—Didn’t you want to become Kim Dokja?

I was speechless for a moment. What does it mean to be Kim Dokja?

I am increasingly unable to understand what it means to be Kim Dokja.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor increases.]

My rough breathing gradually calmed down.

Kim Dokja was silent for a moment, but then spoke in a calm voice.

—Now, let’s check the reward.

"You mean the Dragon Heart?"

—That's good too, but start with that first.

Faintly glowing fragments were visible where the body of the giant Earth Dragon had fallen. However, the shape of the fragment was a bit unusual.

'Sponsor-nim, that...'

—That's right.

There was something reminiscent of a small doll lying there.

A doll whose left arm and right leg are missing.

It was much smaller and patchier than I remembered, but it was unmistakable.

It's clear.

It resembled 'kkoma Kim Dokja'.

I stretched out my trembling hand and picked up the doll. Then the doll slowly opened its eyes and looked at me.

No. Maybe it's not me—

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' looks at his fragment.]

At that moment, the kkoma Kim Dokja doll trembled slightly. Maybe it looked like it was crying.

It wasn't crying because it was scared.

—Okay, can you see me?

A cry that sounds like it missed him a lot.

Kim Dokja spoke in a sweet voice, as if comforting the doll.

—It's okay now. Rest assured.

After hearing Kim Dokja's voice, the doll slowly closed its eyes.

As if waiting for an important choice.

—Hakhyun-ah.

I took a deep breath. I knew what to do, but my feelings were complicated.

—Hold the sword. Hurry.

'Huh?'

—Hurry!

It was then that a crack appeared in the air. A black hand appeared through the completely torn space.

The hand that appeared when Sergeant Jung Moonho died at Seoul Station.

The hand rushed towards the kkoma Kim Dokja doll in my arms.

When Sergeant Jung Moonho was in there, he was helplessly taken away, but this time it was different.

—Now!

At the signal, I cut down the hand rushing towards the fragment.

The hand that touched the blade crumbled into dust. Then a painful cry rang out from beyond the crack, and the crack closed in an instant.

Kim Dokja sighed and opened his mouth.

—I guess there are people other than us who collect 'fragments'.

I think there is.

I remembered the theater of Asmodeus where 'kkoma Kim Dokjas' gathered.

—It's not him this time. That one...

I knew it the moment I heard his voice. If Kim Dokja were in front of me right now, he would definitely be frowning.

—They are probably the ones who killed 'me'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 691 Episode 24 Expert (1)

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After the hunt for the Earth Dragon species ended, the survivors of Gwanghwamun began maintenance.

There were quite a few people who were injured or died during the scenario. If this were the beginning scenarios, it would have been natural to see some people panicking, but people were calmer than expected. As if we were already used to tragedies like this.

"Come on, all the injured people this way!"

"There are only regular supplies left of Elaine Forest, so bring the seriously injured here!"

"We are going to start dismantling the 5th grade dragon species, so if you have any remaining stamina, please help!"

Under the leadership of gangster king Bang Cheolsoo, people dispersed in an orderly manner to find their respective roles.

It didn't seem like people were simply influenced by Bang Cheolsoo's leadership. This is because many of the people who remained here were not part of the Geumho Station group.

The incarnations were being controlled by the shadow of a person who was not here.

[Fragment of the story 'Crazy Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' nods.]

This scenery was created by Yoo Joonghyuk over the past 45 days.

A Regressor who values efficiency.

A person who believes that survival is better than death, and that it is better to swing a sword once during a time of sadness.

I suddenly became curious.

What kind of ending is Yoo Joonghyuk dreaming of in the 41st round?

Come to think of it, I never once asked.

What is the scenery he wants to see at the end of this world?

"Hyung! Are you okay?"

At that moment, Bang Cheolsoo came over and spoke to me.

"I'm okay. What about you?"

"I'm fine."

Contrary to his answer, Bang Cheolsoo's injury was not light at all.

A long stab wound extending from the neck to the chest. Additionally, there are bandages wrapped around his thighs and arms.

Nevertheless, Bang Cheolsoo's eyes were courageous without deceit.

—That's great. He got [Accelerated Recovery] and [Burning Battle] in only the seventh scenario.

Meanwhile, Kim Dokja seemed to have observed Bang Cheolsoo's condition through [Character List].

—It would be useful as a large shield when Lee Hyunsung is not around. I guess I'll have to redraw the power balance table for the 41st round.

'When did you make something like that again?'

"Is it really okay to share the 5th grade dragon species parts with the group?"

"Do it that way."

"Thank you so much, hyung!"

I willingly gave the 5th grade dragon species to the Geumho Station group.

I could have had it, but I thought it wasn't humanly right.

—Did you know that the 5th grade monster species obtained in the beginning have quite a good price tag?

'I know. But they are the people who stayed to protect me. Besides, we still have some parts of the 4th grade Earth Dragon species left.'

—Of course, 4th grade is much more valuable.

'I may need help again in the future, so I have to look far ahead. Bang Cheolsoo and Dayoung and her mother have high growth potential. If I equip them with new equipment like a 5th grade dragon, they will become quite strong.'

—Bang Cheolsoo… I didn’t know there would be an episode using the tech tree, but... yeah, it’s not a bad choice for now.

Fortunately, Kim Dokja seemed to agree with my thoughts.

'Would it be a good idea to exchange the 4th grade Earth Dragon species parts on the Dokkaebi bag?'

—Leave that to me.

With those words, a message appeared in the air.

[Your constellation is requesting a solo treatment from the Dokkaebi 'Bihyung'.]

[Dokkaebi 'Bihyung' agrees.]

It seemed that Kim Dokja had begun negotiations with the Dokkaebi to dispose of the parts of the Earth Dragon species.

I don't know anything else, but I believe in my constellation when it comes to transactions.

Kim Dokja is the person who won the 10-0 contract from Bihyung.

Kim Dokja came back sooner than expected.

—I'm done talking. Coincidentally, there were kids in the U.S. who wanted parts for the 4th grade Earth Dragon species, so we decided to negotiate with Bihyung and make it an exclusive deal.

It's America.

There were a few faces that came to mind.

—That's right. It's who you think. Since it is an individual with a record of evolution, it will be sold more expensively than expected. You can easily get more than 300,000 coins, right?

300,000 coins.

Considering the future scenarios, it was an amount that would be of great help.

Suddenly, it occurred to me that it was a good idea to have Kim Dokja as my sponsor.

'How do I store it? Should I dismantle it myself and upload it to the exchange?'

—No, they said they would visit in person today to appraise and dismantle it. Just have the kids cover up for the public.

Coming? Are they going to pick this up themselves?

—Because it is an expensive item. Have you checked the scenario rewards?

"Ah yes."

Jung Heewon and I, the main contributors to this scenario, received special compensation.

The reward is 'Lesser Dragon Heart'.

—That's a good thing. It only had qigong characteristics that had no basis.

'My [Circulatory Delay] is also a good trait…'

—It’s okay. Even if you achieve a great awakening with that characteristic, it will only be at the level of the Ark of the Beggar Sect.

'No, he was also a great constellation.'

—Then why didn’t you sign a contract with that constellation?

'Should I use the Dragon Heart now?'

—You can use it right away, but I don’t recommend it. Even if it's a low-level dragon heart, it's hard to find. It would be better to absorb it with the help of an expert.

The help of an expert...

'Dragon Heart' literally means the heart of a dragon. It could be seen as a kind of spiritual entity.

And when it comes to absorbing spiritual entities, there are probably many people who are well-versed in the 'Murim' field.

'Shall we ask the Ark for help?'

—He's busy these days. Because of you, they have lost so much money that they must be busy repaying their debt.

For some reason, I haven't seen him in the channel lately.

‘Then go to Murim...'

—'Murim' is the 20th scenario area. It's a waste to wait until then, we have to resolve it here.

'Here? Are there any elixir experts in Korea?'

—There’s a person you can meet soon who isn’t in Korea...

As if there was some confusion, Kim Dokja's words were cut off. It felt like he was talking to someone other than me.

I instructed Bang Cheolsoo to store the 4th grade Earth Dragon species parts and moved to the ward to check on Jung Heewon's injuries.

Fortunately, the injuries were treatable with 'Elain Forest Spirit'.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' is relying on you.]

[The target's 'madness' is currently calm.]

In the end, Jung Heewon became a 'Mad Butcher'.

Even the death of Sergeant Jung Moonho could not change this development.

However, in this round, Jung Heewon is not the Mad Butcher I know.

It was strangely different from the setting of 'TWSA'.

Originally, the 'Mad Butcher' was a person obsessed with her lost family.

But this Jung Heewon...

"Ehw..."

Is she having a nightmare?

I wiped away the sweat that had formed on Jung Heewon's forehead.

While I was wondering if it would be a good idea to give her another dose of 'Elain Forest Spirit', a message appeared before my eyes.

[One 'exclusive transaction' was concluded through the 'exchange'.]

[150,000 coins were obtained as a down payment.]

A sudden shower of coins.

Next, a message was heard.

—Hey, who on earth did you sign with?

Dokkaebi communication. It was Bihyung's voice that I hadn't heard in a long time.

—How can a sponsor be like this? With your... Constellation-nim. Lol. That's not it. As you said, the transaction is... Oh no. Please leave that matter to the higher-ups...

Just like that, the Dokkaebi communication was cut off.

What on earth are you being threatened with?

—Did you receive the deposit?

'Yes.'

I wanted to ask what on earth he was doing, but I held back. Because there were more important things left to do now.

—Then the scenario rewards have been sorted out and now that’s dealt with. Let's do it.

'Do we do it now?'

—Uh.

I took a quick look around.

The hospital room was a single room, so there was no one there except for me and Jung Heewon, who had fainted.

"All right."

With a light sigh, I took out the 'Fragment of Kim Dokja' from my pocket.

It was the same doll I got after defeating the Earth Dragon species earlier.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' looks at the 'Fragment of Kim Dokja'.]

I knew it without anyone telling me.

This 'doll' can absorb the fragments in the same way I absorbed them.

—Do it faster. It's not even the first time. You've already collected six fragments.

'Me?'

I wondered when on earth I had collected so many fragments.

[Disappearances collected to date: 6]

There were scenes that suddenly came to mind.

When I rescued Max at Chungmuro Station.

When the fate of Bang Cheolsoo and the people of Geumho Station changed.

When I met Shin Yoosung in the 41st round.

When we had a battle with the Ark of the Beggar Sect at Seoul Station.

When I made Lee Dansu into an 'Immortal King'…

Disappearances

I definitely heard the message that 'Disappearance' was recorded at that time.

Could it be that 'disappearance' is everything?

—Did you remember?

'Are those all fragments of you?'

—Our fragments, to be exact.

Only then did I feel like my mind was putting things in order, one by one.

—Because it’s not necessarily just the fragments absorbed by the monster species. Some fragments are nestled among the stories. They’re falling asleep in a story they want to read.

A story they want to read.

Without realizing it, my hand holding the doll became tense.

—Has anything changed every time you collect fragments? Your abilities have increased.

'The instigation skills have been strengthened.'

My [Incite] skill gained proficiency at a truly abnormal rate.

I've already surpassed level 10.

Aside from that, there was a change every time I collected the small pieces.

Like when I got [Sentence Enhancement], and when the [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint] skill was suddenly activated.

—Of course. The more fragments you collect, the closer you get to becoming a complete 'Kim Dokja'.

A complete Kim Dokja.

Does that mean that if I collect all the fragments in this way, the 'Kim Dokja' I remember may return?

—First, absorb it. If we continue to wait, they will come again.

Those guys.

Now that I think about it, Kim Dokja said.

They are those who killed 'me'.

If you think about it, it was incomprehensible.

'The Oldest Dream' is no different from the <Star Stream> itself.

Who on earth could kill Kim Dokja in such a state?

'Does that black hand have something to do with your current condition?'

—Maybe. I don't know because I don't remember exactly.

With those words, I could feel Kim Dokja's gaze looking down at the doll.

—If you absorb it, it might come to mind.

I pursed my lips and looked down at the Kim Dokja doll.

Normally, I wouldn't have hesitated this much. If it's a fragment, I already absorbed it earlier.

The problem was the form of the 'fragments'.

A doll that clearly resembles 'kkoma Kim Dokja'.

I hesitated and then slowly extended my hand towards the doll. Then a story came out of the doll.

「'Let’s meet and go, Kim Kyungsik. Do you remember sending me a message before?"」

A voice I already know well.

「"Ah, I’m an old person here so I’m talking like an old person."」

I said, hastily taking my hand away from the doll.

"Wait a minute, this is—"

It was definitely true. Even though it was damaged in some places, this 'kkoma Kim Dokja' was someone I knew.

Kim Kyungsik.

An old man I met in the theater dungeon. He read the novel completely 6 times. A reader with an unusual way of speaking.

I knew that he had gone missing from the Palace Museum, but I had no idea he would end up like this.

If I retrieve the fragment here and now, what will happen to this person?

—Youngest.

Light sparks were seen flying in the air. They were signs that the cracks were about to open once again.

—If you wait any longer, they will come again. If it is taken away this time, there is really no way to get it back.

'But—'

If we absorb Kim Kyungsik now, what will happen to Kim Kyungsik?

—That friend. Don’t you want to save it?

'Is there a way?'

—Perhaps. It's hard right now, but... To do that, you first have to reap his soul. That's the only way to revive him.

My feelings were complicated, but for now I had no choice but to believe Kim Dokja's words. If we delay any longer, a fragment will be stolen by the Black Hands again.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' opens its mouth.]

The story moved like it did when it absorbed the fragments before. However, it was different from the last time when it greedily absorbed the fragments of the story. The feeling of wrapping the doll very gently, like swallowing a fragile cookie.

At the last moment, the doll slowly opened its eyes and looked at me.

「"Finally."」

The fragment seeped into me along with the voice.

[A new 'Disappearance' has been acquired!]

[Fragment of the story 'Kim Kyungsik' was recorded.]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' succeeded in predation.]

[The status of the story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' increases slightly.]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is satisfied.]

[Time limit of 20 days has been added.]

20. I acquired a lifespan that was incomparably longer than when it absorbed small fragments.

That wasn’t even all.

[The exclusive skill of the story fragment 'Kim Kyungsik' will be transferred to you.]

Unlike when I simply absorbed 'fragments', this time there was a definite reward.

[The exclusive skill 'Acting Human' has been acquired.]

Kim Kyungsik’s skill, [Acting Human].

An evasion skill that allows you to transform into a gas at any time and avoid danger as long as you have the Gombangdae item.

It was then that I heard someone's voice behind me.

"What have you done just now?"

Since when did it start?

Someone was standing beyond the wide open hospital room door.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 692 Episode 24 Expert (2)

"Seonah-ssi."

Goo Seonah.

A reader who joined Kim Kyungsik from the 'Theater Dungeon'.

Number of complete reads: 8.

Her nickname is Lady Cheolgon.

She was last heard of in the Palace Museum's Star Jewel Dungeon and fortunately appears to be safe.

"I asked… what did you do just now?"

The problem is that she witnessed a very embarrassing scene.

My mind was confused.

How far did Goo Seonah see?

I took a deep breath and thought over and over again.

Looking at it calmly, from someone else's perspective, it would have seemed like I had just broken a doll that resembled Kim Dokja.

It's a bit of a suspicious scene, but it makes me look like that.

Is it serious enough to be questioned?

"How did you get that skill-"

Skill?

Belatedly, I looked down at my fingertips.

The surface of the nails that came into contact with the steam from the humidifier installed in the hospital room.

It was shaking subtly.

The characteristic of the skill [Acting Human] was revealed naturally.

"This."

It was definitely a situation that could have been misunderstood.

If Goo Seonah saw me using the skill of Kim Kyungsik, who died as soon as I absorbed the doll.

Then suddenly a thought occurred to me.

But can we say that it is a misunderstanding?

Anyway, we have to talk.

I need to explain what is happening to me and what the situation is.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is activated!]

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint activated at will.]

Then, I began to hear someone’s true thoughts.

「Obviously, Kim Kyungsik was dead at that time.」

It was clear even without asking whose true thoughts these were.

「I clearly saw him die. I definitely saw it.」

"Seonah-ssi?"

As I took a step closer, Goo Seonah took a step back with a fearful expression.

Her memories were flooding through her mind.

A place surrounded by damp stone walls. In the dungeon of the collapsed National Palace Museum, she was surrounded by the Misreading Association.

「"Kill her. This is an opportunity to kill an apostle."」

I couldn't tell whose voice it was among the members of the Misreading Association.

What is certain is that in the dungeon she was surrounded and her life was on the line.

「"Recover the fragments! Never miss it!"」

That she was not the only apostle in this place.

「"Seonah-ssi. Roll up the front!"」

The two fought brilliantly. It was only natural since both of them had completed Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint. However, the number of enemies was too high, and they even encountered a dungeon guard along the way.

Just as there are scenarios that even Yoo Joonghyuk, who has gone through countless regressions, cannot handle, there is bad luck that even readers who read Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint completely cannot avoid.

It was a blind arrow that they normally wouldn't have paid attention to.

Goo Seonah, who had high agility, easily dodged the arrow.

The problem was Kim Kyungsik who was behind her.

With the sound of something being pierced, Kim Kyungsik fell to his knees. It was the timing when his specialty, [Acting Human], reactivated.

「"Grandpa!"」

Kim Kyungsik, who coughed up a handful of blood, smiled bitterly and said.

「"Shit. It's wrong."」

「"What are you talking about, you can still buy 'Ellaine Forest's Spirit'—"」

「"I'm poisoned. I won't be able to last even 10 minutes at most."」

Kim Kyungsik must have read her expression and smiled brightly.

「"It's okay."」

Goo Seonah doesn't know what kind of person Kim Kyungsik is. What was his real name, where did he live, how many people were in his family.

She doesn't know anything.

All she knew was that her friend Kim Kyungsik had read and liked the same story as her.

「"You promised. I said we'd see the end of this world together."」

「"I did. So run away. Then I too will survive."」

Goo Seonah couldn't bear to ask what that meant.

Because she was afraid of the approaching enemies. Because she didn't want to die.

Goo Seonah ran away alone. She continued to run away without even looking back.

Kim Kyungsik's last words were like the lingering scent of an extinguished cigarette.

It stuck in her head.

「"Didn't we all in this world originate from one person?"」

I took a step closer to Goo Seonah. Goo Seonah cried out in frustration.

"Oh, don't come! Don't come!"

Goo Seonah's bloodshot eyes were frightened.

"I-I didn't kill him!"

Goo Seonah wasn't surprised because she thought I had absorbed Kim Kyungsik. Now she is faced with her own guilt that she had been ignoring.

"I didn’t kill him! It's not because of me... It's not because of me!"

Goo Seonah turned her back on that path and started running away.

The moment I tried to call her again.

—Don't chase her.

Kim Dokja stopped me in a calm voice.

—That's not something you can solve.

As Goo Seonah's back moved away, even though I know what he said was right, I couldn't take my eyes off it.

Someday, there will be a chance to explain today's events again.

Until then, I could only hope that her heart would recover safely.

—Let’s prepare for the next scenario. You have to chase after Yoo Joonghyuk.

In the midst of the urgency, I had forgotten for a moment.

Originally, I had planned to participate in the final part of the 7th scenario with Yoo Joonghyuk.

But midway through, I got a 'Story Penalty', and Yoo Joonghyuk abandoned me and left.

—You know that that kid is not in a normal state right now, right?

'It felt like regression depression.'

I don't know the reason, but Yoo Joonghyuk's regression depression in the 41st round appeared to be in severe condition.

That's probably why he tried to use me as a kind of suppressant.

—If you go too late, that bastard might kill Anna.

If that happens, things will get messy.

'Anna.'

—Let’s leave as soon as Jung Heewon wakes up, understood?

Jung Heewon. Anna, Lee Hyunsung...

When I think about it, Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation', is their leader.

He did not call them in a friendly tone.

That's because he doesn't consider this world his own.

Or is it that he intentionally wants to keep a distance?

'Constellation-nim.'

Although I am Kim Dokja, I do not know Kim Dokja’s heart.

I don't know why he's helping me or what he expects of me.

So I had to ask.

—Huh.

'Now tell me.'

Why couldn't Kim Dokja return to his companions?

Why did all this start?

'Who on earth are the people who killed you?'

---

To conclude, I could not get a proper answer from Kim Dokja.

—First of all, it is clear that the Giant Nebula guys are involved.

'In this worldline, are there any major events that do not involve a 'Giant Nebula'?'

That wasn't what I wanted to hear.

'No matter how huge the Nebula is, can they kill you? It would be impossible for even Mythical Constellations.'

Even thinking about it again, I still don’t understand.

'Able to kill Kim Dokja, who has the status of the 'Oldest Dream'.

Is there a being in this universe that can even touch the tip of his hair?

How many will there be?

—Something complicated happened in the middle. It's long to explain and my memory isn't perfect.

"You said earlier that if I eat that fragment, you'll remember it."

—I thought so, but I can't remember properly. Okay, but let's talk about it...

After speaking up to that point, Kim Dokja didn't answer for a long time.

I wondered why.

[There is too much usage of 'Midday Tryst' today.]

[Excessive probability has accumulated in the relic.]

Tsutsutchut. The smartphone rattled with a sound.

Well, no matter how much it is [Midday Tryst], it is not normal to share so much information and messages with your sponsor from the beginning.

Fortunately, the probability issue was quickly resolved.

[Please pay additional coins.]

After all, there is nothing that cannot be done with coins.

I waited for a while. I thought that Kim Dokja would soon start talking again.

"Constellation-nim."

But no matter how long I waited, Kim Dokja didn't continue the conversation.

"Hey."

Could it be that you don't want to pay with coins so you're not saying anything?

Should I pay again?

[Your Constellation is looking at you.]

As a test, I tried doing nothing and staying still.

[Your Constellation is looking at you.]

Let's pretend not to know.

[Your Constellation is looking at you!]

[Your Constellation is looking at you!]

[Your Constellation is looking at you!]

The moment I finally decided to put in the coins thinking that it really wouldn’t work with this person, a portal was seen swirling in the center of Gwanghwamun in the distance along with the sound of ki-ee-ing.

At this time, I wondered what kind of portal it was, but when I looked, people who were not Korean came out of the portal.

"I’m here to purchase the 4th grade monster parts! Is the seller here by any chance?"

The one who shouted was a woman with brown hair in the lead.

Even though it was my first time seeing this face, I knew immediately who it was the moment I heard her neat tone of voice.

Selena Kim.

It must have been Anna Croft's right-hand woman, Selena Kim.

As expected, it appears that Anna's group 'Zarathustra' was the one who applied for the purchase of the 4th grade Earth Dragon species parts, as there would be only a few groups willing to pay more than 300,000 coins at such an early stage.

"Cheon Inho-ssi! Are you there?"

By the way, does Selena Kim's arrival mean that Anna Croft also came?

People started buzzing, so I decided to make my presence known.

"That's me!"

Selena Kim spotted me as I approached and waved my hand.

She bowed her head and said hello.

"Cheon Inho-ssi?"

"Yes, that’s right."

"Nice to meet you. I’m—"

"Selena Kim, is that right?"

"Do you know me?"

My eyes widened and my heart pounded as I saw her.

I never thought I would see Selena Kim in person.

The feeling is new.

I survived this far.

"It is. The king’s guardian."

"Ah."

"Nice to meet you."

Selena Kim, with her cheeks blushing, bowed her head to express her gratitude.

"Thank you. That’s very kind of you. I’m a little surprised."

"No, as far as kindness—"

"The King is a very scary person, so I was honestly nervous."

It seems that Selena Kim has already made contact with Yoo Joonghyuk. Does that mean she was in a hurry to make time during the scenario?

As if my prediction was correct, Selena Kim quickly got to the point.

"Where is the 4th grade Earth Dragon you registered for sale—"

"Did you catch the '4th grade Earth Dragon Species'?"

It was then that the woman in the back stepped forward.

A voice I heard for the first time and a face I saw for the first time. Her hair had a hint of pink. She is one hand shorter than Selena Kim.

She had funky makeup, but she was a woman in a neat suit.

"Who are you?"

"I asked if you caught it."

Was there anyone in Anna's group who was this rude?

I answered in a voice with a twisted judgment.

"Such a deb show."

The woman didn't seem at all embarrassed by my response.

"Okay?"

Her eyes shone brightly as if she was having fun.

"Yes, this is it."

There was a pocket watch in her hand.

For a moment, an alarm bell rang in my head.

I instinctively activated [Incite] and held 'Unbreakable Faith' with my right hand.

"You’re quick to notice."

But that one was faster.

A pocket watch that moves in both directions.

I thought I should take my eyes off the clock, but my pupils didn't listen.

Because that was that kind of item.

Yeongmyeon’s pocket watch.

Only then did I realize who the incarnation in front of me was.

In the entire Ways of Survival, there is only one incarnation with that pocket watch.

Finger snapper, Christina Page.

The incarnation of America who cleared the first scenario by achieving the achievement 'Demagogy Killing' incitement like me.

[Your total magic power is lower than that of the caster.]

[Due to the effect of Pocket Watch of the Immortal Face, your skills will decrease for 2 seconds.]

It was only 2 seconds, but it felt like eternity.

"From now on you will."

Christina's smile sent a chill down my spine.

It burned and spread.

"You'll fall into a terrible sleep."

My consciousness went off with the sound of someone snapping their fingers.

---

Christina thought as she looked at the man with his head bowed in front of her.

'I was worried after hearing it from Anna, but it turned out to be nothing more than I thought.'

It seemed like he was quite quick to notice, but she took him by surprise.

It was impossible to avoid her hypnotism in the first place.

"Christina, what on earth is this?"

"What?"

"There was no plan like this! How could you be so rude— Our purpose is to purchase parts of the 4th grade earth dragon species..."

Christina, seemingly tired of hearing Selena's nagging, responded while rolling her eyes.

"You really don't know anything, kid."

"What do you mean?"

"Why do you think Anna sent me with you?"

"..."

"If we're only going to buy parts for the 4th grade Earth Dragon species, all she has to do is send the innocent you. Why would she send this body along with it?"

When Selena Kim hesitated, Christina seemed like she couldn't do it.

She shook her head.

"Damn, if you have brains, think about it. Since there are no items for sale, what kind of person would buy parts for a 4th grade Earth Dragon species? Sell it for 500,000 coins?"

Christina said, tapping Cheon Inho's frozen forehead with her fingertip.

"If you work at the FBI for a few years, you can get a feel for what happens. A slim figure with a sly look. Especially these narrow eyes."

"If the FBI's investigative method is to judge only by appearance, then I will no longer trust the FBI."

"No. Of course, I'm not saying that's what the FBI says—a Korean colleague of mine once said that in Korea, a face like this is: a scammer..."

"Christina."

Christina felt like she was hearing another sound, so she quickly added.

"Anyway, the payment amount still exceeds the pre-deposited 150,000 coins. Now let's get our things together and leave. Since it's a shameful crime, I'll take some bonuses in moderation—"

"Christina!"

"What again?"

Selena Kim's expression hardened as she turned her head to look at her annoyed face.

Christina later realized that something was off too.

Something was holding her fingers.

"Wow, I’m trying to save coins, but I end up doing all sorts of things for it."

Only one of her fingers was caught. But her body seemed frozen and did not move.

'How—'

She tried to say that it couldn't be possible.

Clearly her hypnosis was successful. He had to remain unconscious and be unable to move for at least a full day.

"It’s overflowing with 150,000 coins… How do you know the market price for the 4th grade Earth Dragon species, since you started the scenarios only two months ago?"

But he moved.

He was even talking.

That wasn't the only problem.

What on earth is this feeling?

Even after her fingers were released, her body did not move.

Her shoulders were shaking like aspen trees, and her lungs felt like they were shriveling, making it difficult to breathe.

The feeling she felt when she faced a Constellation one day.

No, it felt even scarier and more distant than before.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' is glaring at you.]

She couldn't turn her head. It seemed like if she turned her head, something terrible would be facing her.

His white, cold hands gently squeezed her shoulders.

"I was only planning to take 500,000 coins... but you can’t do that, you guys."

With a light spark, a cold breath, like a devil's whisper, reached her ear.

"Go tell Anna I want to see her face."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 693 Episode 24 Expert (3)

Selena Kim couldn't understand what was happening in front of her eyes.

Is this really the proud Christina Page she knows?

"Again. How much?"

"It’s 500,000 coins!"

"Just give it to me."

"Yep!"

Former FBI forensic hypnosis expert and the brains behind 'Zarathustra'.

Is that really the Christina Page she knows?

"I’m giving this to you cheaply. You know it, right?"

"Of course I know!"

"I heard it’s more expensive than the market price?"

"When I looked into it again, the price wasn’t that high! If there is demand but no supply, it’s natural for the price to go up!"

"It makes sense now. Then let’s make it 650,000 coins."

"Yes?"

"Let’s increase the price. According to the law of supply and demand."

"B-but 650,000 is too expensive—"

"You dont need it? Then just end the transaction."

"It’s not a matter I can decide on my own... Can I contact the higher-ups for a moment?"

Is this also part of the FBI investigation?

Selena Kim, who was dumbfounded, asked what the hell was going on in the group chat, but Christina just rolled her eyes and said nothing.

She said, 'Don’t think nonsense and just stay still. Please.'

It almost seemed like that kind of look in her eyes.

The reason Christina makes such a fuss is that it was the first time since the symbol of the Demon King descended on the American continent.

In fact, there was something even more bizarre than that.

"Selena Kim."

"Yes? Oh, yes."

The man who was so cruel to Christina was kind to her.

"Aren’t you thirsty?"

With a grin on his face, the man had one of his associates serve her a drink.

"You seem tired, so please recharge."

A sweet-smelling drink with rice grains in it.

"Ah... This drink. I've heard of it."

If you think about it, it could have been nothing special.

But when was the last time she received such consideration in this world?

"Thank you..."

Selena Kim drank her sikhye with great emotion. The sikhye was sweet, the scenery of Gwanghwamun was old-fashioned, and the stars in the sky were clear.

[The Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' says that a glass of sikhye is the best when times are tough.]

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' nods.]

Korea is good.

---

As I watched Selena Kim calmly drinking sikhye from afar, I wondered if I was still under hypnosis.

For your information, the following message appears in my head every time Selena Kim takes a sip of her sikhye.

[Old Constellations from the Korean peninsula watch polite Selena Kim eat.]

[The Constellations of the Korean Peninsula are proud of you for promoting the culture of the Korean Peninsula.]

[The Constellations of the Korean Peninsula will sponsor you with 1,000 coins.]

And the coins are shamelessly being deposited to the person who has now entered my body.

'Look. Dokja Kim-ssi.'

Kim Dokja did not answer.

['Midday Tryst' is extended.]

'Here.'

—Oh, did you extend it? You should’ve done that sooner.

'...'

—It’s Zarathustra. I warned you that it was going to happen, but is that really what you wanted?

Was that why he sent a series of indirect messages?

I knew he did that to save coins.

'Please switch now.'

—I want to do that too... Is it okay? You'll be like this for a whole day.

Christina Page's exclusive hypnosis skill, [Daily Invoice].

Anyone hit by this skill falls asleep and literally looks like a corpse for a day.

In other words, if Kim Dokja leaves my body now, my body will just go limp.

'But are you okay? Even if you descend like this—'

—Who said it was a descent? Are you going to suffer from the aftereffects?

When I thought about it, it was like that.

Now it’s the seventh scenario.

No matter how high the level of the Constellation is, it is impossible to descend directly into the scenario even if they throw away all their stories like the Ark in Seoul Station.

I don't know if he borrowed the power of an Outer God and possessed me.

I don't think Kim Dokja would have done something like that.

'Then now this is...'

A hypothesis suddenly popped into my head.

'Did you use [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint]?'

Kim Dokja’s exclusive skill, [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint].

—Yes.

'But how?'

As far as I know, for Kim Dokja's [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] to activate, there are three prerequisites.

One, the target must be a character.

Second, the caster and target must be thinking about each other at the same time.

Three, he must have an appropriate level of understanding of the subject.

A question arises here.

Even if we overcome the second condition of thinking about each other and the third condition of understanding, how did we satisfy the first prerequisite, 'characters'?

'If...'

I had an ominous feeling.

It's as if the other 'apostles' have become characters.

Have I also become a character?

If that's why Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint was activated...

—Have you forgotten who you possessed?

'Ah.'

The body that Kim Dokja is now possessing from [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] was not originally mine.

'Are you possessing Cheon Inho?'

—That's right.

A sigh came out belatedly.

Certainly, if the target is 'Cheon Inho', the prerequisite of 'character' can be satisfied.

'Then what about the condition of thinking about each other? How was it satisfied?'

—I don't know about that. Weren't you thinking about me right before you passed out?

'That's true. But I'm not Cheon Inho, am I?'

—It was a thought you had while possessing Cheon Inho.

Is it?

There's something suspicious about it, but anyway, Kim Dokja's plan was successful. I couldn't deny that much.

'Anyway, thank you. Thanks to you, I survived.'

—By the way, you too have possessed a truly unique body. Of course, Cheon Inho...

'What... It's weak, though.'

—No, it's not that problem. Doesn’t this body seem a little strange? If you really look at it, neither you nor I are the original owners of this body.

'That's right.'

—Then where is this child’s soul now?

'Uh...'

It was a problem I had never thought deeply about.

I suddenly remembered Shin Yoosung from the 41st round.

When the spirit of the possessed Shin Yoosung escaped, the 41st round Shin Yoosung regained her body.

If that were a normal phenomenon, Cheon Inho's soul should have returned immediately after my soul escaped.

But Cheon Inho’s spirit did not return.

"Here, 650,000 coins."

As if she had just finished the phone call, Christina, who was back, handed me the coins.

"The parts of the Earth Dragon species are over there."

Kim Dokja coolly grabbed the coins and pointed at the corpse of the 4th grade Earth Dragon with his chin.

Christina checked the body without saying anything and nodded her head.

"Confirmed."

Subsequently, a 'subspace warehouse' appeared in her arms.

Portable storage space used when transporting large parts.

Of course, it’s 'Zarathustra'.

Perhaps because they are a group sponsored by <Asgard>, all the items they use are of high quality.

"Then we’ll just leave."

"Okay, let’s go."

"Yes?"

"We should go meet your boss. I said I would see Anna’s face."

Christina and Selena Kim looked at each other with puzzled faces.

It was an expression that would never have occurred to them that he would put such thoughts into action.

"Didn’t you hear from Joonghyuk? I decided to go to America too."

"Joonghyuk... are you talking about the Supreme King?"

Was she very impressed by the fact that King Yoo Joonghyuk was called that?

Selena Kim thought about something for a moment and opened her mouth.

"Okay, let’s go together."

"Selena?"

"Christina, we are in dire need of just one helper. There is no reason to refuse if he is coming to help."

"No, wait—"

"Then I guess the conversation is over."

Kim Dokja wrote a simple note and handed it to Bang Cheolsoo, who was waiting behind him.

"Bang Cheolsoo, please give this to Heewon when she wakes up. In the meantime, please guard Gwanghwamun well."

"Yes!"

Of course, Bang Cheolsoo, who had no idea whether it was me or Kim Dokja, just saluted repeatedly with a blank expression on his face.

"Okay then, let’s leave."

---

After a while, I entered the flickering portal and asked Kim Dokja.

'But Constellation-nim.'

—What?

'Have you ever been to the United States?'

The United States of America. The land of freedom.

'I’m nervous because it’s my first time.'

I lived my whole life in Korea, speaking only Korean.

I never thought I would go on my first overseas trip like this.

In a world where everything has been destroyed.

—Once you get there, it won't be a big deal.

Well, once you become a Constellation, overseas travel will be nothing.

What is everything about overseas? These beings are capable of interstellar travel, and then a thought occurred to me.

In this round, has Kim Dokja ever been to the United States?

"We’re here."

Is it because it is not an interstellar portal? The space transfer ended in an instant.

Kim Dokja and I slowly looked around. A desolate sandstorm blowing from all directions.

Selena Kim must have read Kim Dokja's strangely disappointed expression, and quickly added,

"This is outside Las Vegas."

Anyone who knows it knows that Las Vegas is a city built in a desert.

In other words, it is not difficult to encounter desert terrain with few people even if you go a little bit outside the city.

"The headquarters is located downtown. Anna and the King will be there too. I'll take this to the city center."

Selena Kim pointed to the boarding vehicle next to the portal.

It was not a vehicle from Earth and I thought it was probably an item purchased with coins.

—Hmm. Is this a small Asgardian mobile?

Kim Dokja quickly scanned the inside and outside of the vehicle and nodded.

It was.

—For a supply item, it was made quite well. Did the Mass-Produced Manufacturer tinker with it?

'Have you ever ridden it?'

—The story is that they are making an entry-level model for Ferragini.

I heard it. Looking at it, the inner tube looks similar.

Kim Dokja got into the back seat of the mobile.

"How long will it take?"

"We have about 30 more minutes to go."

"Can I take a nap?"

"Yes? Yes. Of course."

Christina, who was sitting in the driver's seat, nodded her head with a nervous expression.

I asked on their behalf.

'You're sleeping?'

—Huh. Wake me up later.

'No, are you really sleeping?'

—Do you think [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] is free? This too has a time limit and is subject to probability. You can't maintain it for 24 hours a day, so you have to divide it up appropriately. There are no coins to waste here.

What I heard was true.

'But, Kim Dokja-ssi.'

Kim Dokja's words should have been right.

'What did you do with the coins that were stolen from me?'

—Huh?

'From the Earth Dragon species, you said I'd earn about 300,000 coins. But 500,000... No. You sold it for 650,000 coins. Not only that—'

[The exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' ends.]

'Kim Dokja-ssi?'

No reply came back.

In fact, haven't I signed a contract with the '9 Won Demon King'?

It seemed like I could hear Kim Dokja snoring somewhere.

When I looked closely, I saw that my body was snoring.

Selena Kim, who was sitting in the passenger seat, turned around and asked.

"Cheon Inho-ssi?"

Selena Kim waved her palm over my face several times and sighed with an incredulous expression on her face.

I was dumbfounded too, but I thought Selena Kim would be outraged.

"Oh my god, Christina. This guy really fell asleep. It looks like your hypnosis is finally listening."

"Congratulations. This was the most annoying nagging I've ever heard from you."

"Why did you do that earlier? That wasn't like you."

As if she was about to talk about the past, Selena Kim carefully brought up the topic.

Actually, it was a topic I was curious about too.

In my opinion, Christina was overly scared of Kim Dokja.

If I had been possessed through [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] rather than [Descent], the status of the 'Demon King of Salvation' would not have been fully conveyed.

Moreover, Christina Page, like Anna Croft, was an incarnation of <Asgard>.

She said, "I haven't been able to contact <Asgard> at all since a while ago."

"It happens often, doesn't it?"

"Even for the Historical-grade Constellations, if you contact them, they will accept it. They are on standby 24 hours a day."

This was a bit of an interesting story.

Lost contact with all of <Asgard>?

If everyone from the Nebula to the Great Constellations have been summoned, something big has definitely happened internally...

After checking something, tension appeared on Selena Kim's face.

"I can't contact them either. What's going on..."

"Actually, I managed to get in touch with a high-ranking person just before departure, but he asked me something strange."

"Something weird?"

The moment I heard the next words, I felt my heart cooling down.

"He wondered if an incarnation smelled like a 'Demon King'."

The Nebula <Asgard> knows about the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 694 Episode 24 Expert (4)

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How is the <Asgard> in the 41st round related to the 'Demon King of Salvation'?

Do they know?

Did they find out the information through readers?

There was little chance of that happening, as most of what the readers say from 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' has probably been filtered.

Or the Giant Nebula that killed Kim Dokja some time ago.

There is a possibility that it was <Asgard>.

However, even if Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father', is the strongest in <Asgard>, would it be possible to kill Kim Dokja?

Shit. You must have seen a Mythical Constellation.

To be honest, I don't understand either hypothesis right now.

In the first place, I was convinced that the 'Demon King' they were talking about was Kim Dokja.

I held my breath and focused on the conversation between the two people.

"Christina, so that’s why you were so polite to Cheon Inho-ssi—."

"That's right."

Christina, reflected in the rear-view mirror, twitched her lips as if disapproving.

"He smells like a Demon King. I didn’t feel it at all at first, but after he fainted and woke up, I definitely sensed it."

"So, does this mean that incarnation Cheon Inho is a member of the Demon King’s family?"

"Probably. Not long ago, when the Demon King’s symbol appeared in Las Vegas, I faced one. The same goosebumps I felt back then were conveyed to me."

By nature, hypnotists and other psychics have a much better sense of energy than other incarnations.

It wouldn't be strange to say that Christina Page, who considered herself to be the best among them, could read the Demon King's unique energy.

Anyway, Kim Dokja is also half a Demon King.

"If it is a Demon King, which of the 72 Demon Kings would it be?"

"I don’t know that."

"Have you had any other contact from <Asgard>?"

"Not at all. After that question, the messages stopped."

The two people glanced in my direction and from then on continued their conversation without speaking.

[Group chat.]

It looks like there's a story that no one should hear.

In the silence that follows, all that is visible outside is a barren desert landscape. I spent my time thinking about future scenarios in my head or observing my sleeping face while snoring.

As I keep looking at this face, it now seems like my real face.

But does It look like a fraudster like that?

But Yoosoung told me I was handsome...

Would it be a good idea to buy a skill like [Humidity Preservation] like Kim Dokja, or to change the atmosphere a bit by obtaining story fragments such as [Casanova's Face]?

Come to think of it, it seems like Kim Dokja is also secretly very thorough in self-management.

You can tell he was concerned about the turtle neck just by looking at the fact that he put a pillow on his neck for a short period of time.

...Neck pillow?

I felt a strange feeling for a moment, so I looked up the item.

**<Item information>**

Name: SSS grade neck pillow

Grade: SSS

Description: This is a 'neck pillow' made by the Mass-Produced Manufacturer. It is characterized by a cute Dokkaebi face drawing.

Users of this pillow do not have any dreams and can enjoy a recovery effect comparable to consuming the essence of Elaine Forest at bedtime.

When a dangerous situation occurs, the [Alarm] function is activated to force the user to wake up.

*This item belongs to incarnation Cheon Inho.

It was obvious with whose coin this person bought the pillow.

Even though it was just a pillow, I looked up the price thinking how much it would cost and my eyes almost popped out.

[The price of this item is 10,000 coins.]

After thoroughly checking the refund policy and return procedures for the Dokkaebi bag, I decided to charge Kim Dokja the amount.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is activated.]

—Phew, I slept well.

What amazing timing.

I fired off questions in quickly.

'When did you buy this pillow?'

—Just before I went to sleep.

'Try to convince me. Before I get really angry.'

Kim Dokja, who had already finished understanding the situation, rolled his eyes.

He started talking.

—Humans spend one-third of their day sleeping.

'Now we don’t have to sleep that much.'

—This is an item that Yoo Joonghyuk and Yoo Sangah also used.

Yoo Joonghyuk used this item?

This item with a cute Dokkaebi face drawn on it?

—That kid is so popular that someone must have given it to him as a gift. Anyway, it's a useful item for us. We faint a lot.

'So?'

—Be sure to support your neck before you fall. If you get a concussion, it's a big deal.

'...'

—And read the options carefully. It is said that it has a similar effect to consuming the essence of Elaine Forest when sleeping.

I calculated it in my head.

'Elain Forest's Spirit' costs 500 coins each.

That means.

—Even if you use it just 20 times, you get your money's worth.

'How many times can I use it?'

—Well. If you use it sparingly, wouldn’t it be able to be used for quite a long time? It says here that after-sales service is also provided.

'I admit. I forgive you for your sins.'

This was a very efficient item, right?

I feel good knowing that I once again made a satisfactory purchase.

After sleeping well, Kim Dokja stretched lightly and looked out the window.

I turned around.

Slowly, the city of Las Vegas was appearing.

[The seventh 'main scenario' is currently in progress.]

[The eighth 'main scenario' is currently in progress.]

A series of system messages appeared.

I was puzzled.

The seventh scenario hasn't even been completed, but the eighth scenario is in progress?

—There was something like this in the 3rd round too.

I remember too. While the fourth scenario was in progress, part of the fifth scenario, the 'Disaster' scenario, was solved.

However, it was a temporary situation at that time, and the two main scenarios did not unfold simultaneously like they do now.

Something seems wrong.

Kim Dokja also nodded in agreement.

'The seventh would be a monster invasion scenario, what would the eighth be?'

For reference, Korea's eighth scenario in the third round was 'The Strongest Scapegoat'.

—That was the third round in Korea. I don't know what it's like here.

'That's right.'

The 'Strongest Sacrifice' scenario is an extreme scenario that ends only when half of the incarnations in the area die or when the strongest incarnation dies.

I hope it will be a smooth scenario in the 41st round.

"We've arrived. You're already up."

"Thanks to you, I slept well."

Selena Kim laughed at Kim Dokja's sly answer.

The entrance to the casino hotel, the symbol of Las Vegas, began to be visible in the distance.

I guess it's because it's still daytime. The hotel street, with the lights off, had a somewhat eerie atmosphere for a gambling mecca.

[The Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' wipes his head with a curious expression.]

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' shakes his head saying that these buildings are not clean.]

[The Constellation 'King Heungmu' boasts that they cannot imitate the architectural style of the Korean Peninsula.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' holds his tongue as he looks at the Constellations on the Korean Peninsula.]

Well, the whole world has already become a gambling den for Constellations, so how meaningful is it to see a human gambling den?

Christina parked her car in front of the largest hotel on Casino Street.

This is the home of Zarathustra.

When the doorman who came to greet us opened the car door, a crowd of people gathered at the entrance of the casino hotel was noticed. A mixed group of people of various races, each with their own weapons.

Kim Dokja asked with a grin.

"Am I not a welcome guest?"

"It’s not our group."

Selena Kim and Christina stood in front of Kim Dokja as if guarding him.

When I saw it, I was a bit puzzled because the local situation on the American side was never revealed in the main story.

But Kim Dokja already knew who they were.

—It looks like the Las Vegas civil war is not over yet.

'Do you know who it is?'

—Las Vegas gang.

Is it like the American ironclad faction?

—It's a much more elite organization than those guys.

'But there is an absolute throne in America too, right? The unification of forces would have been achieved.'

—Have you already forgotten what we did?

It occurred to me later that Kim Dokja killed the founder of the absolute throne.

What if America’s 'absolute throne' also lost its effectiveness like the one in Korea did?

Now that the throne's absolute power has disappeared, it is naturally useless.

—Anna must be having a headache too.

Naturally, it is a powerful force that fills the place where the throne has disappeared.

A powerful force that can claim to be the king.

Before we knew it, the leader of the group approached us.

A long fur coat and a T-shirt with a skull on it. A cross necklace shining in silver. A Hispanic man wearing a cowboy hat that looked like something out of a western movie. Even at a glance, he was giving off an unusual vibe.

"Who are you?"

When Kim Dokja asked, Selena Kim answered.

"Jacob Martinez. King of North Las Vegas."

When the man got close enough, Selena Kim took a step forward and said,

"Mr. Martinez."

The man responded, nodding his head towards Selena Kim.

"It’s been a while. Guardian of the King."

"What’s going on here?"

"I came to see the Prophet."

It looks like Anna Croft has some business to do over there, just like us. Judging by the ghastly atmosphere, it didn't seem like the visit was for good reasons.

Christina, who was watching the situation, intervened.

"I’m sorry, but Anna has plans today. Why don’t you come next time?"

"Get out of the way."

"If it’s urgent, tell me what you want. I’ll tell her."

Martinez glared at Christina with a cold gaze.

"We have come to demand compensation."

"Compensation? What compensation?"

"Our group suffered too much damage during the subjugation of the 4 grade monster species. We demand compensation for that."

4th grade 4. It seems that a similar level of monster species has appeared in the United States as well.

"The damage was all the same."

"We lost our entire home. It’s because your masterful touts guided the direction of the 'disaster' to the northern part of Las Vegas."

"It’s not Anna’s fault. Even Anna can’t do anything about a natural disaster."

"Are you saying the Prophet couldn’t read the future?"

"Hey."

"She must have seen the northern part of Las Vegas flying away with her vision of the future. Yet the Prophet did not give us any indication."

"..."

"If the response had been a little late, all the women and children would have been swept away to death."

Before I knew it, Kim Dokja and I were listening attentively to the two people's argument.

Anna must have had her own reasons for not telling them everything about the future.

But if someone else dies in return, whose responsibility is it?

How much responsibility does a Prophet who knows the future bear for not telling the future she knows?

Christina answered with a frown.

"I'll discuss compensation and coin support. So, leave at this point. Unless you want to make a big deal out of it."

"I guess I need to meet the Prophet."

With a clanking sound, Martinez pulled out his pistol from its holster. At the same time, the group guarding him also pointed their weapons in this direction.

If this continues, a large-scale armed conflict is expected.

But Christina didn't look nervous. There was already a pocket watch in her right hand.

Martinez said.

"I already know about your hypnotism skills."

"..."

"Would it be faster for your watch to tick? Or would it be faster for my bullet to blow a hole in your head?"

"You can try it now—"

Everything happened in an instant.

Was it first that I heard the sound of a fur coat flapping, or that the person who had been the doorman a moment ago transformed into Martinez?

Front and left. The two Martinezes opened their mouths at the same time.

"You seem to have forgotten who I am, hypnotist."

Before we knew it, Martinez's pistol was touching Christina's left eyebrow. Biting her lip, Christina slowly dropped her watch, holding both of her hands above her head.

I asked, somewhat impressed by Martinez's skills.

'How did he do it? Avatar?'

「Avatar is the author's unique skill.」

So, is Martinez also a 'writer'?

—That guy is a 'magician'.

Magician?

"Hypnotist, I am going to kill you from now on."

"Martinez, wait a minute."

"If anyone moves, I will shoot immediately."

Martinez, who glared at Selena Kim, added as if warning.

"I'll count to three. If your leader is really a 'Prophet', she will come out on her own. She would have read the future where her subordinates will die."

Martinez immediately started counting to three. A cold count without any hesitation.

However, even when the count reached 1, Anna Croft did not appear.

"It seems the Prophet's name was fake. Otherwise—"

The trigger was pulled.

"She didn't value you at all."

And there was someone who moved a little faster than the trigger.

"Anna won't come out."

As expected, everything happened in a split second.

No, it was probably a long and leisurely time, even though it only lasted a moment.

Kim Dokja slowly raised his arm and gently wrapped the end of the pistol as if holding a teacup.

"She can't see the future right now."

Nevertheless, no one except me could witness his actions.

Christina, Selena Kim, and Martinez all looked shocked.

A face of disbelief as to how on earth this was possible.

[The Constellation 'Humanity's First Magician' is astonished.]

Only I knew the method used by Kim Dokja.

It was neither skills nor magic.

[The story 'The Stone and I' ends.]

Martinez came to his senses late and urgently pulled the trigger.

Click. Click.

But the pistol did not fire.

[The story of 'The Pistol and I' continues.]

Kim Dokja snatched the pistol at once and pulled the trigger into the air as if he was joking.

"Because I came."

With a bang, a congratulatory shot rang out announcing our debut in Las Vegas.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 695 Episode 24 Expert (5)

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We sat in the lobby of the casino hotel and waited for Anna Croft.

Christina, who hesitantly brought out refreshments, lowered her head when she made eye contact with Kim Dokja. Apparently, she had learned her Korean greeting from her 'Korean colleague'.

She said, "I was indebted to you a little while ago. Thanks to you, I survived."

"Congratulations on your survival."

"I’m serious."

"I sincerely congratulate you on your survival."

Christina nodded her head as if it was somewhat strange to hear his sincere tone.

"Thank you. Anna will be here soon."

"Tell her to come quickly. I don’t like waiting."

"Hey, can I ask you a question?"

"No."

"Did you happen to know the King of the North?"

"I saw him for the first time today."

Even before coming to Las Vegas, I had a premonition that Kim Dokja would have an accident.

I felt it was right since I signed a contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

There is a magician performing dazzling tricks in front of him, and that magician happens to be an 'obstacle' that stands in the way of his meeting with Anna Croft.

But if he happens to have the power to remove obstacles.

Kim Dokja was not one to miss that.

[Some Constellations are amazed at your feat!]

[You received 500 coins.]

Because this world gives coins to such shows.

The problem is that the 'obstacle' that was removed showed an unexpected reaction.

—Are you... Korean?

—And?

—Your name?

—Cheon Inho.

Why? The moment he heard the name, Martinez's expression changed.

—Look at that friend, let’s go back now. I will come back in half a day.

That was all about the 'magician incident' that happened a little while ago.

Kim Dokja destroyed Martinez's magic and took away his pistol.

After hearing my name, the magician realized something and disappeared.

'No matter how much I think about it, there's an important thing I’m missing.'

Perhaps my fame has spread to Las Vegas without me knowing?

But no matter how much I think about it, there’s no way that’s possible.

—There are more famous Koreans other than us.

'Ah.'

Yoo Joonghyuk must have started talking about it as soon as he arrived, so it was understandable that he was afraid of Koreans.

However, I don't think Yoo Joonghyuk would have told him not to touch other Koreans, but he walked away much more obedient than expected.

—I don't know that much either. Do you know what kind of god I am?

That's right, God.

—And it's more fun not knowing.

'It’s the same when you’re sightseeing.'

While Kim Dokja and I were exchanging opinions, Christina and the men began carrying the parts of the Earth Dragon species.

I could feel the passing incarnations observing us with curious eyes.

Young men carrying whole wyrm bones and children hiding behind the reception desk and spying on us.

Probably all of them are Anna's 'Zarathustra'.

Selena Kim, perhaps embarrassed by the gaze of her colleagues, spoke to her.

"I’m sorry, Cheon Inho-ssi. The headquarters is still a little messy."

"It’s okay."

That's not just a polite thing to say, it's really okay.

The 'Demon King of Salvation' usually likes to receive attention.

[The Constellations of Las Vegas pay attention to the appearance of the incarnation 'Cheon Inho'.]

Of course, it also depends on the type of interest.

Kim Dokja was also observing people with interest, perhaps because it was his first time seeing 'Zarathustra' during this time.

"It looks like they just settled here."

Selena Kim slightly nodded her head, as if surprised by Kim Dokja's observation skills.

She said, "Yes. We just moved to the Las Vegas Dome."

"I guess you were originally at the 'Washington Dome', right?"

"Yes, that's right."

"How’s the situation in Washington?"

The main scenario revolves around the capital 'Dome' of each country.

Just as Korea has the 'Seoul Dome', the US scenario would have developed around the 'Washington Dome'.

However.

"Washington is already..."

Selena Kim's expression was dark.

What on earth has happened to America in the meantime?

And why did they leave the Washington Dome and go to Las Vegas?

Did they move to a 'Dome'?

'Constellation-nim.'

—Huh.

'Will the Las Vegas Dome actually open at this timing?'

—The building itself is not the problem.

According to the settings of 'Ways of Survival', additional domes are created or additional people are summoned for certain countries as the scenario progresses.

Considering that additional people were summoned to Korea as well starting from the 'seventh scenario', it was not surprising that a new 'Dome' was opened in the United States, which has a larger population than Korea.

The problem was this.

—The problem is that restrictions on movement between countries have been lifted.

Originally, 'Dome' area restrictions were not lifted until the tenth scenario was cleared.

Of course, there are global scenarios like 'Peace Land' where you can meet incarnations from other countries, but in that case, the stage was likely to be another planet, not Earth.

However, the target region for this scenario was 'the United States'.

[Limited to this scenario, 'zone restrictions' will be temporarily relaxed.]

[You are participating in this scenario as a 'mercenary'.]

[You will be assigned a new seventh main scenario.]

A scenario that requires 'mercenaries'.

This meant that the management office also acknowledged that this 'main scenario' could not be cleared by American incarnations alone.

"Where is Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"He will be near the scenario area. The King and his party headed to the scenario area as soon as they arrived."

Judging from the fact that he said he was a 'party', it seems that Yoo Joonghyuk did not come alone.

Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, Kim Namwoon, Lee Seolhwa... Perhaps other readers, including Ji Eunyu, also came.

What happened to other people?

Will Dansu ahjussi or Kyung Sein be safe?

Selena Kim asked in a curious voice, perhaps because the story of Yoo Joonghyuk came up.

"Are you close to the King?"

"We are life and death companions."

Selena Kim seemed to be thinking for a moment about what that meant.

Kim Dokja didn't seem to be expecting much of an answer either. His gaze was focused on the parts of the Earth Dragon species that were being transported inside the hotel.

She said, "The parts of the Dragon species will not be easy to process."

"We can. If you want, I can show you."

"Good. Let’s take a look while we wait for Anna."

We walked along the marble hallways inside the hotel.

This would definitely be 5 stars.

If it had been before the destruction, I wouldn't have even dared to enter a place like this, but I thought life was really strange.

When I opened the door at the end of the hallway and entered, a huge hall appeared.

"Bring the head this way!"

"Starting with bone number 4, one by one!"

"Gather the leather in front of shelf 8!"

"Eyeball! Where is the eyeball?"

Craftsmen who dismantle parts of the Earth Dragon species in real time and artisans who process the dismantled parts.

At first glance, they were all elderly incarnations.

Selena Kim introduced them.

"These are the 'supporters' that 'Zarathustra' is proud of."

Even in the <Star Stream>, where anyone can become stronger if they work hard, there are definitely innate abilities.

As evidence, older incarnations inevitably have lower initial abilities, and there is a high possibility that they will naturally fall behind in the scenario or be eliminated from the competition.

There are also incarnations who do not want to fight, even if it is not necessarily because of their age.

"Not everyone can participate in a combat scenario. Each incarnation has a specialty, and some are better suited for support."

I was a little impressed. Selena Kim's words were obvious, but some 'obviousness' is not as obvious as you might think.

'Zarathustra's reputation is not false.'

No matter how weak the incarnations are, the group's strength is clear.

It was not an easy decision to train their support abilities despite the recent loss of power.

Nevertheless, Anna Croft boldly bet on a future that never came.

There must be confidence that someday their usefulness will yield greater benefits.

However, it seems that we Korean con artists are not very happy with the Las Vegas gambler's decision.

Kim Dokja was staring at the pile of dirt that occupied one corner of the excavation with incomprehensible eyes.

People were sprinkling something that looked like fertilizer on top of a bowl-shaped pile of waste.

"Are you growing crops?"

"Yes. We need to prepare food for the future soon."

Selena Kim continued speaking as if reciting lines that had already been prepared.

"One day, when the scenarios are over, humanity will have to grow its own food again. Anna is preparing for that time."

The plants that grew in the field were species that did not grow naturally on Earth.

A plant from another planet, like 'Yanaspleta', which appeared on Earth during the Kronos erosion.

Kim Dokja looked down at the plant stem, then bent down and lightly grasped the gray soil. As soon as the soil touched Kim Dokja's hands, it quickly rotted and crumbled.

—It's not the dirt of the earth.

'Dirt from another world.'

Currently, there is only one condition for the existence of 'dirt from another world': 'planetary invasion'.

In other words, this soil was created when the fifth scenario, the 'disaster scenario' occurred.

'It's strange. If the fifth scenario was cleared normally, all of this dirt should have disappeared as well.'

Why does this 'dirt' still remain in the United States?

Kim Dokja lightly waved his hand and looked back into the hall once again.

The parts of the Earth Dragon species, which had already undergone basic processing, were being transformed into blunt-looking weapons.

Looking at weapons that were questionable as to whether they could be used, Kim Dokja sighed.

"I don’t know if you know, but 4th grade monsters’ parts are not cost-effective materials. They are difficult to process compared to parts of the same class, and their sharpness after processing is somewhat inferior. Actually, it’s not something worth buying for 630,000 coins at this early stage."

Suddenly, Kim Dokja confidently confessed that he had committed fraud.

"Normally, it is normal to purchase the bones of the highly efficient '5th grade fire dragon species' even if the grade is low. However, you purchased the 4th grade earth dragon species. You even had to waste money."

However,

"I know. Anna said so too."

Being aware of a fraudster's scam means that it is no longer a 'fraud'.

Kim Dokja, who was accidentally cleared of being accused of being a fraudster, continued.

"If you bought it knowingly, it means that there was a reason why it had to be 4th grade. I think."

As Kim Dokja said those words, he picked up a handful of the powder that had fallen during processing.

"I think it’s probably because of this."

He then sprinkled the powder on the contaminated soil.

['Purification' effect occurs.]

[The eroded soil has been purified.]

At that moment, everyone in the hall stopped their actions.

The craftsmen who were cutting bones and the craftsmen who were tanning leather all stopped their work and were looking at Kim Dokja.

Some incarnations were also seen secretly grabbing the weapons they were wearing around their waists.

"Selena Kim. I think you’re a good person."

Kim Dokja's eyes were already showing a cool aura.

"I’m going to ask a few questions, and I hope you’re still a good person, and nothing will go wrong here."

Several artisans jumped up from their seats. Selena Kim lightly raised her hand and blocked the artisans.

Kim Dokja asked.

"Selena Kim. Anna is not at the 'headquarters' right now. Is that correct?"

"..."

"You brought me here to kill time, because I shouldn’t interfere with your plans."

Selena Kim lowered her head and said, as if she realized she couldn't hide it anymore.

"That’s right. I’m sorry."

"Is it true that you cleared the fifth scenario normally?"

"That—"

"Where is Anna now?"

It was at that time that a small roar was heard from the hotel entrance.

[The Constellation 'Ender of War' enters the channel.]

[The Constellation 'Thursday Thunder' enters the channel.]

[The Constellation 'Guardian of the Big Horn Bridge' enters the channel.]

I could feel the Constellations of familiar modifiers entering the channel.

Outside the window, I could see a portal created at the hotel entrance.

A portal to another area.

There was a doll slithering through the portal.

We went straight down to the hotel entrance.

When I arrived at the first floor, I saw dazzling blonde hair flowing outside the lobby.

Aloof red eyes shining through blonde hair.

The Prophet Anna Croft was there.

She must have been injured during the scenario, and blood was constantly flowing from her left arm.

Anna Croft opened her mouth to Selena Kim, who quickly took care of her tourniquet.

"What about the parts of the Earth Dragon species?"

"I brought it. A small amount can be put in right away. Even now—"

Anna Croft shook her head.

"It’s too late."

Selena Kim's face turned pale.

"No way—"

"The operation failed. I don’t know why, but I can’t see anything in [Future Sight]. I guess I’ll have to give up on the Washington Dome."

Several pieces of information were quickly combined in my head.

4th grade Earth Dragon species and [Purification] characteristic.

Washington Dome.

Disaster scenario.

And... companions.

My heart began to beat loudly.

I guess not. Probably not.

「"He smells like a Demon King. I didn’t notice it at all at first, but I definitely smelled it after he woke up from fainting."」

Why did Anna Croft return 'alone' from that portal?

With Christina's voice passing through my head, an ominous feeling arose.

I wasn't the only one who got that premonition.

"Anna Croft."

The moment she heard that voice, Anna Croft's expression hardened.

With her stiff neck she slowly turned around.

"You... how are you here?"

"Where is Yoo Joonghyuk now?"

The 'Demon King of Salvation' that I knew until now felt more like a neighborhood unemployed brother than a Constellation.

He hates being boring, isn't very serious about everything, and is busy making fun of people whenever he gets the chance.

Now that guy,

"I’m asking. What happened to Yoo Joonghyuk?"

He was truly angry.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 696 Episode 24 Expert (6)

Why is Kim Dokja, the neighborhood brother, so angry?

The first word that came to mind was 'colleague'.

He saw the end of the scenarios with Yoo Joonghyuk in the third round.

Watching Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round, the neighborhood brother may have recalled memories of those days. Even though he knew that the Yoo Joonghyuk of this world line was not the 'Yoo Joonghyuk' he remembered, the neighborhood brother became shaken by his crisis.

「Is that really the reason?」

It was a very romantic reason, but honestly, it didn't make sense to me.

This is because Kim Dokja, the neighborhood older brother I observed so far, had a corner that was tightly twisted.

I don't know if all the separated Kim Dokjas are like that, or just the 'Demon King of Salvation'...

「He resembles Kim Dokja in the early days of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' a lot.」

Kim Dokja, who likes 'Ways of Survival'.

Kim Dokja, who thought Yoo Joonghyuk was a psychopath and kept a strange distance from the characters.

Kim Dokja, a scenario expert.

If my assumption is correct, this is why Kim Dokja is angry now.

「Now he doesn’t like this 'story'.」

Sparks bouncing lightly in the air. Even though it was a possession through [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint], the level of emotion was revealed in blue.

Anna Croft's pupils shook in surprise.

[Eyes of the Great Devil.]

The moment I saw Anna's burning red eyes, I wondered if I should stop her at this point.

If I leave it like this.

[The exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is activated!]

[The activation of 'Eyes of the Great Devil' is canceled due to the effect of the 'Fourth Wall'.]

Because Anna Croft will die before we can confirm whether Yoo Joonghyuk is alive or dead.

"Tsk—"

With a crackling sound, blood vessels burst from Anna's eyes. Anna, holding one of her eyes, took a step back.

"How could you—"

"I’ll ask you one more time."

Kim Dokja's hand slowly moved to the hilt of his sword.

"Where is Yoo Joonghyuk now—"

Lights in the area flickered as if there had been a power outage. And in the next moment, the light disappeared from Kim Dokja's eyes as if the factory's power was turned off.

I immediately realized what was happening.

[The exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is deactivated.]

—Oh, I forgot the duration.

'Constellation-nim?'

—I'll exchange some coins for you. Hang in there.

'Kim Dokja-ssi! Kim Dokja! You bastard!'

Kim Dokja had no answer.

If you disappear like that, what are they going to do to me?

Before we knew it, the forces of 'Zarathustra' were gathering one by one, centered around Anna Croft.

The tense expressions of the incarnations showed an evil and murderous look, and Selena Kim was also watching the confrontation with a troubled expression.

And my body stood tall, unconscious.

'Shit.'

It was also surprising that the fainted body was able to stand still.

Does Kim Dokja have a story like 'balance artist'?

To make matters worse, because my eyes were narrowed, she didn't even notice that I had fainted.

"You... what the hell are you?"

Anna glared at me and continued her words.

"It definitely didn’t feel like this before... Are you really Cheon Inho? Even then—"

"..."

"Are you going to continue to be silent?"

Despite Anna Croft's questions, my body remained silent and motionless.

Anna Croft's expression hardened, as if she thought that was some kind of answer.

Because I fainted while holding the hilt of my sword, it seemed like I was contemplating whether or not to kill the incarnations in front of me.

Anna Croft spoke again with a determined voice.

"I don’t know what you’re thinking, but this place is Zarathustra. If you try to destroy this place—"

"Anna!"

Selena Kim, whose complexion turned pale in real time, eventually intervened.

"You shouldn’t fight with Cheon Inho-ssi. He is not a bad person."

"Selena?"

"This person... served me a Korean drink. It was delicious."

"What on earth are you talking about?"

Selena Kim, who had been rolling her eyes nervously, turned to look at me.

I wondered why she was so nervous, but when I thought about it, there was a good reason.

"Cheo-Cheon Inho is the Demon King."

Shit.

"Demon King?"

"Well, Christina…"

A commotion spread throughout the hall, and several people sat down and screamed.
They only heard one word, 'Demon King' (마왕), but the panicked people looked at me and took a step back.

It was a situation that could not have happened under normal circumstances.

There is no way that the incarnations of the seventh scenario would know what the 'Demon King' is.

But they were different.

「"...I also faced the Demon King's symbol when it appeared."」

There was something I could guess about this.

But no matter what they went through, I am not the Demon King.

My sponsor is a Demon King, but I am not one anyway.

The smart Anna would of course know this.

Probably, 'I am the Demon King' is an impossible story at this point.

However.

"Did you ultimately choose 'that path' in this round as well?"

The Prophet suddenly started talking frantically.

"Everyone, step back. As of this time, we are abandoning Zarathustra's temporary headquarters."

The hall became a chaos. People running out of the hotel screaming.

"Selena Kim. Put on level 1 alert. I'll buy you some time. In the meantime, you—"

I couldn't wait any longer for Kim Dokja to return. But what can I do after being thrown out of the body?

'No.'

When I thought about it, there was a way to move my body even while unconscious.

A method I have used before.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated.]

「Incite on myself who has fainted.」

「Cheon Inho let go of his hand holding the hilt of his sword.」

Fortunately, the body listened.

As I let go of the hilt, I saw Anna Croft, who had been leading the people, stop.

But this alone is not enough.

Would more specific incite be possible?

For now, I had no choice but to give it a try.

「Cheon Inho opened his mouth.」

The next moment, a voice miraculously came out of my stunned body.

"I can’t believe the mere word 'Demon King' is enough to make you go crazy. That’s where Zarathustra’s fame ends."

Anna Croft looked at me with an expression of disbelief on her face.

Squinted eyes with a subtle smile. Distinctive smirking lips.

Anna Croft asked.

"Cheon Inho. Could it be... your memories have come back?"

---

This wasn't the first time I encountered 'Anna Croft'.

At the beginning of the scenarios, I had already met Anna through 'Phantom Prison'.

「Who is it? You... are not Cheon Inho.」

If I think about it, Anna doubted me even back then. Perhaps because she is a Prophet and has a great sense of insight?

Anna, who was sitting on her chair in her living room and glaring at me, opened her mouth again.

"The one who deceived the stars. Is it really you? Please answer clearly."

The one who deceived the stars.

Even hearing it again, it is still a grand nickname. What did Cheon Inho do in the 40th round to be called that?

"Is it really that important who I am?"

Anna Croft frowned at me as I whirled around.

"How did you get your memories back? There’s no way Yoo Joonghyuk shared the story..."

I received a fragment of the story, but it wasn't the story.

I answered honestly.

"I am not the 'Cheon Inho' you remember. All memories were reset with Yoo Joonghyuk’s [Regression]."

"That..."

"Isn’t it the same for you? You will not be the Anna Croft from the previous round, but the new 'Anna Croft' who has taken over the memories from the previous round through [Past Sight]."

"I guess it’s you, seeing as you’re coming up with plausible sophistry."

Anna Croft shook her head as if she had a headache and drank the tea on the table in one go.

From afar I saw Selena Kim watching this way with worried eyes.

I waved my hand in that direction as if to reassure her.

"What is this about the 'Demon King'? Why do Selena and Christina think you are a Demon King? Did you really make a contract with a Demon King?"

He's a Demon King, but if you ask if he's really a Demon King, it's a bit ambiguous.

"Did you choose 'that path' again like last time?"

That path?

"Are you sure you want to talk now?"

Since the conversation was likely to be tense from the start, I decided to lighten the mood a bit.

"Just calm down and think of me as the 'new Cheon Inho' from now on."

"New Cheon Inho?"

"Not all evil people are evil from the beginning, you know?"

"You are a villain."

"By stigmatizing them like that, the world’s evil-doers cannot be rehabilitated."

"What..."

"From now on, think of me as a newborn. Depending on your choices, this newborn may later become a vicious killer or a good deceiver."

"You are not a newborn."

I thought about inciting myself as a 'newborn', but instead I said this.

"But Yoo Joonghyuk must have thought that every time he saw me."

"..."

"Should I kill this guy or save him? Which one will be more helpful to the future of this world? If I make the wrong choice, how much tragedy will happen in this world?"

I looked out the window at the streets north of Las Vegas.

A desolate city swept away by a disaster.

Anna jumped up from her seat and drew the curtains on the window.

I said this to Anna.

"Just knowing about some futures is a sin. In that case, I will just live as a newborn who knows nothing."

"Why on earth did you come here?"

Anna said without looking at me.

"If you got your memories back, you can live your life as you please. The intention is to make this round a mess—"

"I came because Yoo Joonghyuk called me."

"Why on earth are you saying such a blatant lie...?"

[The character 'Anna Croft' is activating 'Lie Detection Lv.7'.]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that what you said is true.]

Anna Croft's expression became strange.

"You said you came because the King called you?"

"Yes."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that what you said is true.]

"Why?"

"Because we're on the same side."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that what you said is true.]

"You're on the same side as the 'King'?"

I turned to Anna Croft, whose lips were quivering, and nodded my head with a shameless face.

"If your curiosity has been answered, I will now ask a question. There must have been other Koreans besides Yoo Joonghyuk, but what happened to them?"

"Why are you asking that?"

"Because they are my colleagues."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that what you said is true.]

"Colleagues?"

Anna Croft looked like she was about to lose her mind.

"You care about your colleagues?"

"Of course I’m worried."

"Cheon Inho, who on earth are you?"

Anna Croft's face, distorted with anger and sadness, she looked almost like that of a madman.

"I can’t trust you. I just don’t understand the King. How could something like that happen and he hires you?"

"I don’t think that’s what you want to say."

Anna Croft's eyes slightly widened at my words.

"As expected, you obtained the memories from the 'previous round'."

I gave up denying it and decided to adjust to Anna Croft's misunderstanding.

Anna said, taking a moment to gather her thoughts.

"The King is still safe. And so are your comrades."

"Are they safe?"

"For now."

I nodded, somewhat relieved.

"Are they in the 'Washington Dome' now?"

Anna nodded with a miserable face.

"That's right."

I knew it. I immediately checked the scenario log.

**<Main Scenario #7 – ???>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: ???

Clear conditions: Go to the scenario area.

Time limit: ???

Reward: ???

Failure: ???

From the moment I checked the seventh scenario, I thought it was strange.

Even when I arrived in Las Vegas, a message appeared telling me to move to the 'scenario area'. This meant that the actual setting of the seventh scenario was not 'Las Vegas'.

"The seventh scenario is underway in Washington."

"What kind of 'disaster' is this?"

"...It looks like everyone already knows."

"Did you fail the fifth scenario?"

"I hate to admit it, but I do."

As expected, the United States failed to hunt down the final disaster of the 'fifth scenario'.

And in return, the 'Washington East' was lost.

The 'Management Bureau', which judged that the American incarnations could not hunt down the disaster on their own, must have moved the probability of the <Star Stream> to stimulate the interest of the Constellations.

As a result, the disaster scenario was extended to the 'seventh scenario' and transformed into a global scenario.

[New incarnations have entered the seventh scenario area!]

By now, incarnations from all over the world are probably moving over to the American scenario.

If we do something wrong, a world war could break out in Washington.

"It’s pathetic. You couldn’t properly deal with a disaster with [Future Sight]?"

If nothing else, this disappointment was real.

I didn't know 'Anna Croft' was going to fail the fifth scenario.

Moreover, in the '41st round', every character exceeded my expectations.

"It’s annoying to hear that from you, but something was different about this world line. Things that I couldn’t figure out even with my [Future Sight] kept happening."

Something that cannot be known even with [Future Sight].

In the main story, such things usually occurred when Kim Dokja intervened in the scenarios.

However, in this round, Kim Dokja was a Constellation, and he never intervened in the story until he signed a contract with me.

But at that moment, a hypothesis popped into my head.

Why didn't I think of that?

Come to think of it, it exists in this world line.

People who can change the future of the world even if they are not Kim Dokja.

"Cheon Inho. Have you ever heard of a group called 'Apostles'?"

Even on this continent, there were readers who read Kim Dokja's story.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 697 Episode 24 Expert (7)

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An hour after Cheon Inho fainted, Yoo Joonghyuk went to Las Vegas.

The group that came with him was as follows.

Steel Emperor Lee Hyunsung.

Maritime Admiral Lee Jihye.

Delusion Demon Kim Namwoon.

Doctor Lee Seolhwa.

Beast Tamer Shin Yoosung.

The five incarnations who have been by his side for the past dozens of rounds.

If you look closely, they were all people with at least one flaw.

Lee Hyunsung was too foolish, and Lee Jihye was too simple. Kim Namwoon was a crazy person, and Lee Seolhwa was often bitter. Shin Yoosung was weak-hearted.

He repeatedly changed the main members or formed new parties several times.

But in the end, these are the five that remain. They were the only ones who stayed by Yoo Joonghyuk's side until the very end.

"Ugh, this is my first time in America. Has Seolhwa unni ever been here?"

Lee Seolhwa answered Lee Jihye's question with a faint smile.

"When I was young."

"Tsk. I know a lot about America. Jihye ya, are you curious?"

"No."

"I'm nervous because the only time I ever deployed troops was to Iraq."

"Hyunsung, you're always nervous."

Compared to the previous round, the mood among the group was brighter.

Yoo Joonghyuk found Shin Yoosung remaining silent alone in the midst of a lively conversation. Although she originally had a dark personality, the shadow that now fell on Shin Yoosung's face was not just due to her personality.

As Yoo Joonghyuk was about to approach Shin Yoosung, a voice was heard from behind.

"That's amazing. Is that the status of the 'Five Heavenly Emperors' who protect the Supreme King?"

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned and thought. Looking back, there was another 'party that came with him'. He just didn't consider them his companions.

"Five Heavenly Emperors? Was there a nickname like that?"

"I attached it."

"Do not pollute the Book of Revelation."

A beautiful woman sighed lightly behind two bickering young men.

Yoo Joonghyuk knew who they were.

Kang Ilhoon, although his tone is harsh, is believed to be the incarnation of an Archangel.

Ye Hyunwoo, the de facto leader of the Chungmuro Group and the teammate of Armed Castle Lord Gong Pildu.

Lee Seyeon who possesses strong interpersonal fighting skills and is armed with S-class or higher items.

They were the incarnations who quickly emerged as new powerhouses in this round.

Although he never told anyone, Yoo Joonghyuk knew one thing the three had in common.

'They are past evil-doers.'

Their names remained in his memories of the last round that came to mind.

Small villains who were major thieves, betrayed their party, or became looters.

These little villains were proudly leading the incarnations to the forefront of the main scenario this time.

To be exact, it wasn't just them.

"Dansu ahjussi, why are you sighing like that?"

Another man and woman followed behind them.

Yoo Joonghyuk even knew their names.

"As expected, I’m worried about Inho-ssi. I should have stayed too."

Although not as strong as Lee Hyunsung, Kyung Sein is the second-strongest tanker after Lee Hyunsung.

Although his fighting skills are not outstanding, Lee Dansu reminds him of 'Selena Kim', who was the Immortal King in the previous round.

If he remembers well, he also had a minor dispute with these incarnations in a certain round.

'Is it a coincidence? Or not...'

Even if it was a coincidence, there was nothing particularly strange about it.

In the countless rounds of his life, every human being, including Yoo Joonghyuk himself, became a villain at least once.

What Yoo Joonghyuk learned through this was that humans are just empty vessels.

All humans become completely different beings depending on what kind of 'tale' they face and what kind of story they live.

He knows it's true.

However, it was not easy to admit the truth that just one man instigated it.

'Cheon Inho.'

So far, without a single exception, 'Cheon Inho' has been a villain in all rounds. Whether small or large, he became a villain and blocked Yoo Joonghyuk's path.

As if that was his absolute mission.

However, 'Cheon Inho' in this round has not yet become a villain.

Yoo Joonghyuk found that fact very strange.

"What are you thinking about?"

Yoo Mia, who was walking next to him, squeezed his left hand. Yoo Joonghyuk spoke without shaking her hand.

"It is nothing."

"You thought of the man with narrow eyes."

"He is dangerous."

"He looks like that old swindler."

"Right."

"But if you listen to what people say, he seems to be a good swindler."

'Good swindler.'

While Yoo Joonghyuk was surprised that young Yoo Mia knew such an expression, he wondered whether he should correct the contradiction in the expression.

But he couldn't think of anything to retort.

Instead, Yoo Joonghyuk decided to recall the memories of the last round.

What a bad guy he was in the last round and how dangerous it is to trust him...

['The Redemption of Truth' controls your memory.]

Redemption of Truth.

One of the three stories he engraved.

This imprint seals some of the memories in exchange for great power.

Although he was a little concerned that this memory had been sealed, Yoo Joonghyuk didn't really care.

In any case, the 'memory' that would be the key to clearing this round was remembered by someone other than him.

"It’s been a long time, King Yoo Joonghyuk."

Across from the casino hotel stood the person whose memories he wanted.

Zarathustra's representative and his old enemy.

"Anna Croft."

---

While heading to the Washington Dome, Yoo Joonghyuk tried to avoid eye contact with Anna Croft as much as possible.

['Emotional restraint' stirs.]

This is because it was difficult to handle the growing excitement in real time.

He wanted to bring Cheon Inho to prepare for this kind of situation.

But it might be too late to turn back now.

"Prophet. There is a memory I need. Use [Past Sight]."

"I exhausted all my reps today."

[You are using 'Lie Detection'.]

['Lie Detection' confirmed that the statement was true.]

Anna Croft's expression hardened at the message about using the skill.

"Lie Detection, do you not have the minimum level of trust?"

"I'd rather trust a good swindler than trust you."

"Who is the good swindler?"

"Don't pry into unnecessary things."

"You brought it up first—"

"I'll tell you in advance, I don't have much patience in this round."

Instead of answering, Anna Croft glared at him with disapproving eyes.

At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk felt the urge to pull out his spear and hit her on the head.

This was because dozens of past tragedies caused by Anna Croft came to mind all at once.

[Exclusive skill 'Redemption Lv.5' is being activated.]

[The influence of 'Redemption' is temporarily weakened by the effect of 'Three Persons'.]

But he had to endure it.

At least she'll be useful until all the Constellations in this world run out.

However, the moment Yoo Joonghyuk checked the local situation, he began to doubt Anna Croft's 'usefulness'.

"Why did the scenario end up like this?"

In only the fifth scenario, the entire Washington Dome was eroded.

The surviving incarnations make up about 5% of the entire population of the dome.

This was something that had never happened in any round before.

"An unexpected situation occurred."

"There’s always something like that."

"I had a plan."

"A plan that cannot be kept is useless. If you cannot come up with a convincing answer, you will die here."

Anna Croft let out a deep sigh at his threat. It was a strangely despondent sigh that he had never seen before in any round.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Have you ever heard of a group called 'Apostles'?"

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded his head.

"As expected... it looks like they were in Korea too."

Judging by the way she spoke, it seemed that Washington's downfall had something to do with the 'Apostles'.

"Could it be that Korea also failed to kill the disasters?"

"I am in Korea."

"Of course it is. I was just asking just in case."

Yoo Joonghyuk ended the fifth scenario in Korea.

A disaster that was different from his memories appeared and the method of dealing with it was a little different from the previous round, but the scenario itself went smoothly anyway.

"It hasn’t been smooth sailing for us."

"I guess I know roughly what the situation is."

Yoo Joonghyuk also heard something about the 'Apostles'.

Beings who know the 'future' of the world.

"That’s what happens because you rely too much on things like [Future Sight]. You probably know that there is no such thing as a fixed future."

"The future was written. Until they showed up."

Anna Croft has been clearing the scenarios by reading the future and preparing for it.

However, in this round, the variable 'Apostles' intervened and all her plans went awry.

"If you help me with this matter, I will definitely repay your debt, King."

"I hope you can continue to be useful until the debt is paid."

The moment they entered the portal, the surrounding scenery changed into waves.

Yoo Joonghyuk had his companions wait for a while and then went up to a nearby high-rise building to check the view.

This was not his first time visiting the Washington Dome.

But it was his first time seeing a scene like this.

It seemed as if the entire city was buried in pitch-black ashes.

There was no sight of living incarnations anywhere.

All the high-rise buildings that made up the skyscrapers were in ruins, and the sky was covered with fog that obscured even the light of the stars.

On the roof of the building, black roots reminiscent of a tree growing upside down were sprouting.

Yoo Joonghyuk tore off the root without hesitation.

Then, a roaring black ether poured out between the torn roots.

A 'dark root' that vomits demonic energy.

It was definitely true.

'The Demon Realm.'

He doesn't know what number this demon realm was, but the 'Washington Dome' was invaded by a demon realm.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who landed lightly on the ground, asked Anna.

"Have you secured the parts of the Earth Dragon species?"

"I’m trying."

In order to fight in an invaded demon world, [Purification] work is essential. Otherwise, you will be cursed.

[Currently, the 'Washington Dome' has been eroded by the demon realm.]

['Local curse' is activated!]

[Spiritual power decreases slightly in the area!]

[Comprehensive stats are partially reduced in that area!]

Judging from the extent of the invasion, it was not yet at an irreversible level.

However, if the scenario proceeds like this, leaving Washington alone, the city will truly become part of the 'Demon Realm'.

As time goes by, the Demon Realm will expand and eventually the entire Earth will fall under the Demon King.

That must be prevented at all costs.

“What kind of Demon King is it?”

Now, let's go to the seventh scenario, the Washington Dome.

The Demon King will not be able to descend in person.

Therefore, there was a high possibility that the owner of this dome was a subordinate of a specific Demon King.

"It was the first time I have ever heard this Demon King."

"Was it your first time hearing about it?"

Yoo Joonghyuk knew the true names of all the Demon Kings who ruled the 72 demon worlds.

The same would apply to the prophet in front of him.

Nevertheless, if a Demon King with a name they had never heard of appeared, the implications of that fact were clear.

"Christina confirmed—"

A new 'Demon King' has appeared in the Demon Realm in this round.

"They called their master the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 698 Episode 25 Demon King (1)

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「There are three ways to become a Demon King. I forgot some of them. But at least one thing is certain. It is to kill another 'Demon King'.」

---

"Demon King of Salvation?"

When Yoo Joonghyuk paused after hearing the modifier, Anna Croft immediately asked.

"Do you know that Demon King?"

I do not know.

Yoo Joonghyuk tried to say that.

This is because among the 72 Demon Kings he knew, there was no Demon King with the same modifier. Nevertheless, the moment Yoo Joonghyuk heard that modifier, he got a headache and remembered someone's voice.

「"There's another sunfish!"」

A mischievous voice, as if calling a close friend.

Friend.

It was strange. Such a concept did not exist for him during his 41 rounds repeated life.

So where does this voice come from and who does it belong to?

He quickly found the answer.

'Memories of another world line.'

It must be a memory that the woman named Han Sooyoung put into his head.

「"Demon King of Salvation."」

He couldn't tell if it was the name of the man in his memory or not. However, in his memory, the emotions of the people who used that modifier were clearly visible.

Some people were happy calling that name, some were sad, and some missed it.

It was a feeling he no longer had.

Yoo Joonghyuk tried to recall the man’s face. However, his face was barely visible as it was cleverly obscured by a pale white space.

What came to mind instead were the items he used.

White coat.

A sword with three properties.

The smartphone he carried around like a talisman…

The moment he thought about it, he got goosebumps.

This is because Yoo Joonghyuk already knew an incarnation who used exactly the same items.

"King?"

Hearing Anna's voice ask again, Yoo Joonghyuk returned to reality.

"It’s an unknown Demon King."

Anna Croft looked at Yoo Joonghyuk for a moment and then said.

"I won’t use [Lie Detection]. I don’t think you’re the kind of person who would lie with something like that."

"You talk like you know me well."

"Of course I know, my lord. Because I inherited all the memories from the last round—"

"I said that I don’t have much patience for this round."

Anna closed her mouth and Yoo Joonghyuk closed his eyes and asked, trying to control his emotions.

"What more did you find out about the Demon King?"

"He is not a high-level Demon King."

"How do you know that?"

"None of the 72 Demon Realms has changed places."

Typically, the strength of a Demon King is determined by the order of the Demon World that the Demon King rules.

For example, 'Andro Mallius', the master of the 72nd demon realm, is weaker than 'Dantalion', the master of the giant devil world.

However, if the existing rulers of the demon realms are alive and well, this means that this Demon King has not yet made it into the rankings.

'Is it luck among misfortunes?'

The Demon King's descendants are influenced by the status of the Demon King they each worship.

For example, in the case of 'Dark Sentinel', a 7th grade demon species, it may rise to 6th grade or drop to 8th grade depending on the type of Demon King it worships.

If the 'Demon King of Salvation' is a low-level Demon King, then his descendants will not be high-level individuals either.

"What kind of guy is the one who took over the East? Still, he must have been at a significant level to the point where he descended as a disaster."

If it's a disaster level, it can't be just a 6th grade or 7th grade demon species.

A demon species of at least 5th grade or higher.

There was also a possibility that he was a fallen aristocrat of a demon realm who was sold as a disaster due to debt to the Management Bureau.

Perhaps a demon baron, a viscount-level demon, or if they're unlucky, a count. If they are really unlucky, it may be at the marquis level.

Anything more than that will not descend due to the influence of probability.

"The only thing I found out was that it was a humanoid. Although there was a harvest where I came face to face with the symbol of the Demon King—"

"The Demon King’s symbol?"

Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardened for the first time. He hurriedly looked around. There have been no significant signs yet.

"Why didn’t you tell me about that first?"

If the possibility of the Demon King’s symbol appearing here was acceptable, it would have been better to give up the 'Washington Dome'.

Anna, who read Yoo Joonghyuk's thoughts, hastily added.

"I didn’t see it in Washington. It was in Las Vegas that Christina came face to face with the Demon King’s symbol."

"Las Vegas?"

The Las Vegas Dome is an early scenario area where demonization has not yet occurred.

No matter how symbolic their body is, no Demon King will be safe from the aftereffects of probability if it appears in such a place carelessly.

Then.

"Did you come into contact through the hypnotist’s [Nightmare]?"

Anna nodded her head.

The hypnotist’s exclusive skill, [Nightmare].

If you use that skill, you can create a 'dream' with a low probability cost and encounter a high-level being even if it's only for a moment.

"They told me not to mess with Washington."

"I need to hear more from the hypnotist. Where is she?"

"I called her, but even if you met her, it would be difficult to hear the details. Even if she did use [Nightmare], the other person was the symbol of a ' Demon King'. It was a difficult opponent for the current Christina. She couldn't sleep for two days right after waking up from the dream. She couldn't do anything, and for a while, she had a seizure every time she talked about it."

If it's that level of fear, there's a high possibility that it really is the symbol of a 'Demon King'.

If a symbol appeared directly as a warning, it means that this is an important area for the 'Demon King'.

"Maybe we should consider the worst."

"If it's the worst..."

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down without answering.

Yoo Mia, who was drawing on the floor, looked up at him as if asking what was going on.

Yoo Joonghyuk twitched one eyebrow and opened his mouth.

"Yoo Mia."

"Huh."

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at his younger sister's face for a long time.

Even now, after his repeated regressions had touched his heart, there was a very faint sense of warmth when he looked at his younger sister.

His only family given by this world.

When the disaster first began, Yoo Joonghyuk made a decision. He will protect this child at all costs. That is all the mission given to him.

There was definitely a time like that.

Afterwards, he lost Yoo Mia.

Lost her once, lost her twice, three times, four times, five times.

After screaming and crying at the sight of his sister's death for more than a dozen times, Yoo Joonghyuk arrived at one truth.

He cannot save his sister.

Until he ends this damn world with his own hands.

"Take this."

A pitch black circle was placed on Yoo Mia’s small palm.

Yoo Mia said.

"This is that thing? That gives a good dream."

Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer, but Yoo Mia seemed to already know everything.

Yoo Mia looked at her brother silently and used a sad voice.

"I just need you to protect me."

"I will lose you."

Both the child and Yoo Joonghyuk knew. Yoo Joonghyuk will risk his life so that this child will never have to use this medicine.

Still, this medicine was necessary.

"When did I tell you to use it?"

"At the end of the end."

"When was that?"

"When all the people you mentioned are dead and there is no one to help me."

"And."

Yoo Mia lowered her head and muttered.

"I don’t like it. I won’t say anything."

Then, she ran towards where Lee Seolhwa was and hugged her.

As Lee Seolhwa consoled Yoo Mia in her arms, she bowed slightly towards Yoo Joonghyuk

Yoo Joonghyuk also nodded his head.

Anna, who had been watching the situation with her mouth shut, eventually said something.

"There’s no need to do that to a child, right?"

"…"

"Do you think you might fail?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at the sky for a moment. If he is right, this round will be his last.

Since he will never get another chance, he must do his best more than ever before.

Nevertheless, a tragedy that exceeds his best can happen at any time.

Just as it has been the case for the past 40 rounds of his life.

Coo coo coo coo.

He could hear monsters moving in the distance.

Yoo Joonghyuk observed the movements of the demon species using a skill.

Devil species and their eggs are spread out in the city center.

It seems that they have already finished breeding, and the low-level demons born in real time have already formed a large army.

Yoo Joonghyuk asked, counting in his head the individuals with high combat power.

"What happened to other countries? You probably didn’t just contact us."

"We also contacted Japan, China and India."

India's Ranveer Khan.

China's Feihu.

Japan's Asuka Ren.

"Japan said that its own scenario was too daunting, and that it would consider China and India."

There are not many countries that can help other countries from the beginning.

They had to take into account the interests and losses of their own country's incarnations, and above all, the risk of recklessly interfering in another country's scenario was high.

Therefore, the judgment of those who did not come here was, in a sense, very wise.

"Shall we wait a little longer?"

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk came here.

"No."

The reason was simple.

"If more time passes like this, clearing the scenario will become impossible."

Once the Demon Realm decoration in Washington Dome progresses to a certain level, the entire American continent will soon begin to be decorated.

Once the American Constellation dominated, it was only a matter of time before the entire Earth turned into a demon realm.

When that time comes, no one can stop it.

What happens on the streets of Washington will happen around the world.

Demons will overflow, and the Demon King will descend.

Then humanity will end.

[The Constellations of Nebula <Eden> are watching your choice.]

"I will stop it."

At the same time as Yoo Joonghyuk's declaration, the roar of a demon bell was heard from afar, as if it had read his will.

[The demons of 'Washington East' recognize your presence.]

A message floating in the air. The contents of the seventh main scenario were displayed clearly.

**<Main Scenario #7 – Demon World Invasion>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: SS+

Clear conditions: Defeat the ruler of the 'Washington Dome' and liberate the 'Washington Dome'.

Timeout: —

Reward: Liberation of Washington East, 300,000 coins, ???

Failure: The fall of Washington.

[You participated in this scenario as a 'mercenary'.]

[When you clear this scenario, you can obtain the same rewards as existing participants.]

[The 'Scenario Mercenary' achievement has been achieved.]

[The army of the 'Demon Realm' is coming!]

Yoo Joonghyuk, who pulled out a spear from his back, gave an order.

"Everyone ready for battle."

Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, and Kim Namwoon came to the front.

The apostles who had been searching the area from the rear also quickly formed a battle line.

"Dansu ahjussi, please take the rear. Sein and Yerin are at the front. The second apostle and I will cover in the middle."

Looking at Ye Hyunwoo's control skills, it seemed like at least they wouldn't be a hindrance.

After a while, behind the ruins of the buildings, demonic species appeared.

Most of them are 8th grade or 9th grade entities. What particularly stood out were the dozens of 7th grade demon species that took the lead.

'Dark Sentinels.'

Monsters that would have annihilated them in an instant if they were ordinary incarnations.

But those here now were not 'ordinary' incarnations.

"Lee Hyunsung."

At the same time as Yoo Joonghyuk's command, Lee Hyunsung shot out like a cannonball.

"Hwaaaaaap!"

Lee Hyunsung, who ran bravely, knocked down the leading Dark Sentinels all at once with [Pushing Mount Tai] and then crushed the ground in the area with [Breaking Mount Tai].

The screams of the demon species rang out through the thick dust.

Yoo Joonghyuk gave an order once again.

"Kim Namwoon. Lee Jihye."

Kim Namwoon burst into unpleasant laughter, swinging the daggers in both hands at random and moving across the battlefield.

"Tsk tsk tsk! Get rid of one tentacle bug!"

Kim Namwoon, who had taken out one of the Dark Sentinels in an instant, let out a strange laugh and accelerated his magic circuit.

The energy of [Black Flame] steadily radiated from the dual-wielding daggers.

Kim Namwoon roamed his battlefield wildly, running wild like a crazy clown.

"You idiot! Back!"

Lee Jihye assisted to fill Kim Namwoon's gaps with a chain of [Ghost Killing] and [Ghost Walking].

Kim Namwoon, who had already suffered stab wounds here and there, smiled brightly and shouted.

"You came to save me as expected!"

"Shut up!"

Shin Yoosung, who was waiting in the back, also summoned Nagak troops to assist in the battle.

['Nagak Cry' is activated.]

The Nagak wailing wave, which shot out like ultrasonic waves, struck the central ranks of the lower-level demon species.

As the demons, blood pouring from their ears, staggered and sat down, Kang Ilhoon took the opportunity and stepped forward.

"Come on, it’s time to go back to hell."

Kim Namwoon glared at Kang Ilhoon with an expression that asked, "What is that guy?"

Kang Ilhoon didn't care and fired the bowgun repeatedly.

Doo doo doo doo!

Archangel Jophiel's [503 units] contained in arrows.

Subsequently, the demon species touched by the arrows exploded into dust, completely destroying the leading ranks.

A force that wipes out a company of the devil species in an instant.

Anna Croft couldn't keep her mouth shut.

"Are you sure you have the incarnation of 'Jophiel''with you?"

"Yes."

"He wasn't there in the previous round—"

The main members of the Dome have not yet appeared. If the other side had the advantage in numbers anyway, it was best to push through quickly before the other side's troops could fully gather.

"Everyone get out of the way."

Magical power reminiscent of cold moonlight appeared around Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round.

[The exclusive skill 'Breaking the Sky River Lv.10' is activated!]

Breaking the Sky River, which had already reached level 10, cut the battlefield horizontally with his ferocious magic power, and the heads of the demon species flew through the air as if they had been cut off by an invisible guillotine.

A gap in the battlefield that occurred for a moment.

Yoo Joonghyuk did not miss the opportunity.

His thigh muscles, wriggling like a wild leopard, pushed the ground with explosive force, and the surrounding scenery was instantly pushed back.

Only Anna, who had the ability to fly, chased after Yoo Joonghyuk some distance away.

"It's over there!"

The [Eyes of the Great Devil], which emitted bright light, read the near future. The path that the demon species was unable to defend was clearly visible before her eyes.

"Right! Next, turn left!"

How long did he run while cutting down the demon species like that? The Capitol building, occupying the center of the village, appeared in the distance.

The moment he discovered the Capitol building with a huge pond in the center, he instinctively realized the power of gravity.

Very disturbing and shady.

He knew it without anyone telling him.

The owner of this 'dome' is over there.

As Yoo Joonghyuk stepped forward without hesitation, air bubbles bubbled up from the center of the pond.

The head of a demon species with long hair slowly emerged.

The pressure that could be felt even just by looking at it was on a completely different level from that of the Dark Sentinel.

It was at least a noble-level demon species.

Without the slightest hesitation, Yoo Joonghyuk swung his spear and split the devil's head. However, there was no feeling of cutting.

Then, the demon species head scattered like a spray of water, and a demon species of the same shape appeared a few steps away.

The demon spoke first.

[As I heard, you are a short-tempered guy. Are you 'Yoo Joonghyuk'?]

With an ominous smile, as if he knew he was coming.

[Come in. 'The Demon King of Salvation' is waiting.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 699 Episode 25 Demon King (2)

As if he had been waiting for him, the demon noble calmly turned toward the entrance of the Capitol.

But Yoo Joonghyuk did not move a single step. His past lives were talking to him.

That's a trap.

Even if it wasn't a trap, he didn't believe anything the Demon King's liaison said.

"Prophet."

Anna Croft had no answer to Yoo Joonghyuk's call.

When he glanced over, she saw Anna Croft staggering around, her complexion pale.

"I don’t know why, but [Future Sight] doesn’t work."

「Future Sight doesn’t work. Even in his last round, Anna Croft's skills often broke down.」

But it was such an odd timing.

Yoo Joonghyuk analyzed Anna Croft's condition with calm eyes and made a quick decision.

"You’re useless whenever it’s important."

Before he knew it, the demon noble was more than twenty steps away.

Yoo Joonghyuk had already obtained information about this guy through [Sage's Eyes].

'It's Viscount Nikhteri the Devil.'

This guy was a 'self-made devil'.

Based on the original scenario difficulty, this guy should only appear in the eighth scenario.

That guy said, 'The Demon King of Salvation is waiting'.

Inside the Capitol, there is a real agent of the 'Demon King'.

Probably, the probability that there is an incarnation capable of being possessed by the Demon King is higher than the possibility that there is a symbolic body.

In that case, he must be considered to be at least an earl-level Demon King.

Yoo Joonghyuk took a deep breath. With each breath, the magical power condensed in his entire body continued to rotate.

In general, 'First cycle of Sky' refers to the circulation of the magic power contained in the Danjeon to all microscopic blood vessels.

However, with his master, 'First cycle of Sky' was used with a different meaning.

Only when the circulating magic draws a complete circle does the body become an eye in itself.

Eyes that perceive the world through expanded five senses.

Through those eyes, humans see the sky. You realize that the sky, which seemed beautiful and wide, was actually a prison in a terrible scenario.

「"In fact, it is to recognize that this whole world is just a joke in the sky. That is First cycle of Sky, the entrance to Breaking the Sky."」

At this point, it was still difficult to count the stars in the sky. However, it was not difficult to count the demon species on earth.

"A total of four?"

Shocked, Viscount Nihterida looked back.

Next, three stone statues radiated a gloomy light from above the stone building of the Capitol.

[The evil Viscount 'Bricolakas' is hostile towards you.]

[The evil Viscount 'Scupedia' is showing hostility towards you.]

[The evil Viscount 'Myrmicoleon' shows his hostility towards you.]

As many as four demon viscounts.

In no round did he face four self-made demons at the same time in the seventh scenario.

Coo coo coo coo coo.

Anna Croft bit her lip as she felt the pressure of the demonic species pressing down on the area.

"They are the demons who killed my comrades."

Perhaps these demons were summoned in the fifth scenario. Starting from only the fifth scenario, it was obvious that no country could handle this level of difficulty.

As Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes gave off a sharp light, the viscounts looked at each other as if they were curious.

Coo coo coo coo.

If it had been the previous round, or if it had been the round even before, Yoo Joonghyuk would never have confronted them. Fighting with four viscount-level fighters in the seventh scenario is tantamount to suicide.

But Yoo Joonghyuk did not back down. Because this round was neither the 39th nor the 40th.

This world is the 41st round.

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk's body disappeared, the three Viscounts simultaneously drew their weapons towards Yoo Joonghyuk.

Brycolakas held the long incense stick that was his main weapon, Scoupedia held the dual-wielding daggers, and Myrmicleon held the swollen drumstick.

Magical energy containing deep evil karma burst out in a semicircle around the three demons.

At that moment , Yoo Joonghyuk's agility had reached the limit of the scenario. However, in the eyes of the demonic viscounts, it was a speed that wasn’t desirable.

The viscounts' eyes were simultaneously nailed to a single point in the air.

"Is it there?"

The spear, dual-wielding daggers, and the drumstick struck a point in the air at the same time. The demonic viscounts laughed along with a cruel explosion sound. They thought Yoo Joonghyuk would have been crushed mercilessly.

However, when the black ether that dyed the air black disappeared, Yoo Joonghyuk was not there.

"What—"

That couldn't have been possible. There was no way just one incarnation could avoid the eyes of a demon noble who had evolved.

The moment when the demon Viscount Myrmicoleon sensed something was wrong, he opened his mouth.

Skag.

With a sound as if the world was splitting in two, the head of Demon Viscount Myrmicoleon was blown off.

For the first time, agitation spread across the demons' faces.

Let's say he’s just out of their sight. However, a viscount-level demon was killed in one blow.

"It does not make sense—"

But to the current Yoo Joonghyuk, it 'made sense'. The power he now manifests was obtained at a high price.

['Restraint of Truth' is activated.]

One of his three story imprints, 'The Redemption of Truth'.

[Some of your memories are sealed.]

'Story Engraving' that unleashes power in exchange for some of the memories from the previous round being sealed.

[All your overall abilities will temporarily exceed the scenario limit!]

[Explosive power surges from your entire body!]

In Yoo Joonghyuk's mind, a memory he cherished was fading away. It was a memory he dedicated.

「"Captain. This is a birthday present. It's my favorite toshi..."」

Lee Hyunsung in the 22nd round, smiling with a simple face. The old toshi he handed him was disappearing from his mind. The temperature of his heart decreased and his heart became infinitely cold.

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk will never remember that smile again. Instead, Yoo Joonghyuk will remember something else.

His long journey of regression has finally come to an end, a memory that will not disappear until the end of his life.

「"Captain. Will you please take revenge in the next round?"」

"I will grant your wish, Lee Hyunsung."

He will remember only sorrow.

I will fight against the sky of this world using the hatred born of that sadness as my driving force.

"You! How dare you!"

The demonic Viscount Scoupedia charged at him, brandishing his dual daggers. The pitch-black river that formed at the end of his weapons streaked Yoo Joonghyuk's cheek.

But even faster than that, Yoo Joonghyuk had already pierced Scoupedia's heart.

Deep.

Scoupedia, who vomited black blood, died. Vrycolakas and Nihterida, enraged, joined forces and rushed forward.

It was an attack prepared to defeat Donggui.

The Ammu created by Nihterida covered the field of vision, and Vrykolakas' long spear split into a dozen pieces and flew in from all directions. Several polearms grazed Yoo Joonghyuk's thighs and waist.

Skag.

Vricolakas' head fell.

Now all that remained was the demonic Viscount Nihterida.

Nihterida, who hesitated and retreated, said,

"What are you doing? Why are you opposing us? The Demon King has no hostility towards you!"

Nihterida, who had even thrown away his pride as a demon species, shouted in a panic.

"Hmm, why would you do something like this? The 'Demon King of Salvation' will definitely be fine if you call him."

Nihterida, realizing that the situation was unfavorable, looked at him then quickly turned back and began to run away.

[The exclusive skill 'Red Pheonix Shinpo Lv.10' is activated!]

Yoo Joonghyuk's thigh muscles wriggled like an animal once again. His footsteps pushed into the ground deeply with a loud noise. Yoo Joonghyuk concentrated his magic power by spinning it around in the air. [Breaking the Sky technique], which extended toward the sky with its centrifugal force.

[The exclusive skill 'Flashlight Lv.8' is activated!]

The magic power gathered turned into holy light and created a large hole in Nihterida's upper body.

['Redemption of Truth' ends.]

As soon as his magic power was exhausted, Yoo Joonghyuk took out the 'Advanced Magic Power Recovery Potion' from his arms and drank it.

The liquid that fell seeped into his entire body.

Yoo Joonghyuk lightly wiped his mouth with a somewhat tired expression then immediately looked at the equipment items dropped by the demon species.

'Ancient demon's necklace.'

'Half armor of great strength.'

'Ammu Belt.'

All three were not bad pieces of equipment.

The 'half armor of great strength', which increased strength, was suitable for Lee Hyunsung, whose main focus is hand-to-hand combat, and the 'ammu belt' was suitable for Yoo Joonghyuk himself to wear.

'I guess I can give this to him.'

The 'Ancient Demon's Necklace', which increases stun resistance, was for the guy who fainted frequently.

It's useless in its current state, so filling it in would be of some help.

Anna asked in bewilderment as she saw Yoo Joonghyuk standing up after finishing maintenance in an instant.

"What on earth did you do?"

"There is no part for you. You didn’t help in the battle."

"That’s not what I’m talking about."

In fact, Yoo Joonghyuk knew what had surprised Anna Croft.

He was incredible. The level of prowess he had just shown was incomparable to any incarnation of the same scenario.

"Did you really make a 'story imprint'? Have you forgotten what the villains who used it said?"

Yoo Joonghyuk also knew the fate of those 'villains'. Some of them had their existence sealed because they could not find a way to get rid of it.

"It’s about borrowing and writing a fictional 'story'. Its power will eat away at your soul and memories."

"It’s none of your business."

"What have you lost in return?"

Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer, but Anna Croft knew what he had lost.

「"Prophet. There is a necessary memory. Use [Future Sight]."」

To a Regressor, 'memory' is everything to existence.

"Why did you do that... Sealed memories don’t come back! Now you’ve lost them forever. Do you even know what that means?"

The disappeared worlds exist only through his memories, and he also maintains his identity by not forgetting those memories.

Yoo Joonghyuk gave his memories in return.

"You will end up becoming someone else. You will not even know who you are."

"You talk like you know who you are."

As if any further conversation was meaningless, Yoo Joonghyuk began to walk away again. There were traces of the demons' blood in each of his footprints.

Anna Croft stared blankly at the footprints he left behind.

If he fails, what meaning will these footprints have?

If there ever comes a moment when even she gives up reading her past with [Future Sight], then who will remember that long record of failures of that Regressor?

Should she make it difficult?

"Wait a minute. Wait, King!"

Anna Croft, who belatedly woke up from her thoughts, quickly followed Yoo Joonghyuk.

However, before he could walk even a short distance, Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly stopped walking. She didn't need to ask what was going on. This is because he saw someone walking out from inside the Capitol.

A formidable magical energy that made his whole body tremble.

"Run, Prophet."

For the first time, Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardened.

"It’s a 'Marquis' level demon."

---

That's where Anna Croft's story ended.

"Wait a minute. So what happened?"

Wasn't some important information missing?

What happened to Yoo Joonghyuk, who fought a marquis-level demon?

If something like that happens, how can you be sure that your companions will be safe?

So who is the 'Demon King of Salvation' over there?

In the end, I couldn't bear it anymore and insisted.

"Could it be that you threw Yoo Joonghyuk there and ran away alone?"

"Before we continue, there’s something I need to ask you."

I already knew what Anna Croft would 'ask'.

In the first place, she started this story to earn time.

The incarnations surrounding the outside of the living room from earlier were proof of this.

Of course, no matter how many incarnations surrounded this place, it wasn't a big threat to me. That is, as long as the combat power of the incarnations is within the realm of probability.

"We have 'tactical nuclear weapons'."

"So?"

Tactical nuclear weapon. It seemed like they had managed to secure modern weapons from the generation before the scenario.

"You're not planning on flying that thing at the Washington Dome, are you? You know there's no point in doing something like that."

A nuclear weapon with that level of destructive power cannot be activated due to the scenario structure.

Perhaps the moment the launch button is pressed against the Washington Dome, the nuclear weapon will stop operating due to the probability aftereffects.

But now, instead of launching a tactical nuclear weapon at the Washington Dome, she brought that weapon to me.

"I heard from Christina that you are a 'family member' of the Demon King."

Perhaps Anna Croft had made up her mind. If necessary, she will use that 'nuclear weapon' here.

"Is the name of the Demon King you serve 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 700 Episode 25 Demon King (3)

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I calmly examined Anna Croft's face. A lot of information could be obtained just by looking at her complexion.

Eyes that have lost some layer. Eye shadow that extends deep to the bottom of the eyes.

She probably hasn't been able to sleep well at night ever since the Washington incident began.

That's why she made this rash judgment now.

"What if I really am a subordinate of the 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

Anna Croft just paused in response to my question and gave no answer.

"Are you going to detonate a nuclear weapon right now? Are you willing to blow up the entire city of Las Vegas just to eliminate one member of demon family?"

"It was me who asked the question."

“Are you going to believe me if I tell you? Don’t you know that [Lie Detection] doesn’t work on me?"

"That’s your argument."

"Do you want to try it out?"

Anna Croft bit her lip instead of answering.

"Anna, you cannot detonate a nuclear weapon. You are the one who wants to protect 'Zarathustra'."

I doubt that the tactical nuke in question will work properly, but Anna Croft probably has no intention of using it in the first place.

If she does that, 'Zarathustra', whom she protects, will also disappear.

"Cheon Inho, what do you know about me—"

"Well, tell me. How full of a sense of duty you are, and why you want to erase all diseases from this world. So, what kind of 'end' do you dream of every day?"

「"Please. You too, come with me to my 'end'."」

I remember what Kim Dokja once heard.

Eventually 'Anna Croft' will arrive at her own 'end'. It might be a brighter end than she thought, and it might not be out of this world either.

"How on earth did you—"

"I know quite a bit about you like this, don’t I?"

Anna Croft's countenance grew serious as the one dominating the conversation changed.

"Anna Croft. It doesn’t matter what my relationship with the 'Demon King of Salvation' is. What matters is that you are desperate right now, and I am the only one left to fight. If you leave it like this anyway, the American continent will be destroyed. Do you want to end this round as a failure?"

Anna Croft looked as if she had been bombed repeatedly. Normally she wouldn't have lost her composure after an attack like this.

But now she was very tired.

"What do you want, Cheon Inho?"

"It looks like we can communicate a little better now."

There were many things I was curious about.

What I wanted to ask most was the fate of Yoo Joonghyuk and his colleagues.

But that question was not appropriate here.

Anna even assured me that they were alive and I had problems to solve first before I could ask that question.

I organized my thoughts in my head.

Kim Dokja is not here right now.

However, if it were 'Kim Dokja', this is definitely how he would have started the conversation.

"Then let’s get straight to the point. Please stop. I know what you’re hiding."

"What do you mean suddenly?"

"No matter how difficult the scenario becomes, it makes no sense for you to be this incompetent."

I remember all of Han Sooyoung's description of 'Anna Croft'.

Although Anna got in trouble every time she ran into Kim Dokja, she only did it because it was Kim Dokja.

She is the embodiment of America's strongest, which even the Regressor Yoo Joonghyuk was wary of. Fulfilling her own prophecy, she eventually deceived even the Nebula and dreamed of a 'perfect end'.

There is no way for a character like that to struggle like this in only the seventh scenario.

"If you don’t want to come out, I’ll make you come out."

That is, unless there is a very deadly interference.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated!]

"Anna Croft. You are currently under [Hypnotic Incite]."

With those words, Anna Croft's pupils shook.

"From now on, you will wake up from [Hypnotic Incite]—"

"No, wait! Wait!"

Anna Croft fell back in her chair with a loud thump of someone hitting her head.

Then, the air shook and a woman appeared from within a transparent cloak. 'Hermit's Cloak'. It was a face I knew well.

"How did you know?"

After possessing a character in this world, a bad habit arose in me.

When a new person appears, use [Reader Comment List] first.

[Check the reader's profile information.]

| |
|---|
| ID: FantasyQueen90<br>Platform: Best Noble<br>Total number of comments: 80<br>Reader Level: 5<br>Number of completed readings: 1 time |
| *You can use coins to check the comments left by the reader.<br>*Currently, the number of comments that can be checked for free is 3. |

When I got into the car heading to Las Vegas, I had already used the 'reader comment list' with Christina, so I knew.

That she is America's 'apostle'.

I slowly looked at the window that appeared before my eyes.

'Best Noble' is an unfamiliar name, so it seems to be an American platform.

Number of complete reads: 1 time.

"It’s strange not knowing. You made Anna Croft look like that. No Anna I know has that much poor judgment."

"..."

"If you brought me here, there must be a purpose. What is the reason?"

Christina Page.

She brought me here even after confirming the indirect message of the 'Demon King of Salvation' in Korea.

It was impossible to think that the Demon King of the Washington Dome was the real 'Demon King of Salvation'.

It would be no different from bringing the enemy's subordinate into her own base.

Still, she did it.

The answer is obvious.

"What is your relationship with the 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

She knows that the 'Demon King of Salvation' in the Washington Dome is a fake.

"Please answer me. Is the 'Constellation' you serve really the 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

Not a 'Demon King' but a 'Constellation'.

I met her eyes again.

The moment I saw her deeply sparkling eyes, I realized what she was expecting.

I slowly got up from my seat, walked over to the window, and opened the curtain that Anna had closed.

The darkness descended faintly. Stars were twinkling in the distant night sky.

I quietly looked up at a star shining there.

"Then what are you going to do?"

How long has it been since then?

Slowly I turned my head and saw Christina on her knees.

"Please."

A broken expression, letting go of everything that had been held in for so long.

"Washington again... Please save our Zarathustra."

---

I installed several safety devices, including [Sound Wave Blocking], to prevent other Constellations from hearing the story.

[Some Constellations are suddenly complaining that they can't see you.]

Fortunately, Anna was also very strict with security, so the Constellations didn't seem to hear our story at all.

"First, let’s release the [Daily Invoice] you placed and then talk about it."

Christina wiped away her tears and canceled [Daily Invoice].

[Your soul returns to its original body.]

The senses of my body were regained for the first time in a while.

Right. This was what it felt like to be alive.

After taking a deep breath, I sat down on the sofa and asked Christina.

"What on earth happened in America?"

Calming down a little, Christina placed the fallen Anna Croft on her lap and began to talk slowly.

After hearing the story, I finished my judgment while controlling my emotions as much as possible.

"To conclude, are you saying that the Demon King who appeared in 'Washington Dome' is not the 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

"Yes."

"What about the symbol of the 'Demon King of Salvation' that you saw?"

"It is true that I saw the symbol of a high-ranking demon species. But he is not a real 'Demon King'. I knew it right away the moment I saw him in person."

I guessed that might be the case.

No matter how much she met the Demon King through the [Nightmare] skill, Christina was still too fine to say she had faced a real Demon King.

If they weren't Yoo Joonghyuk or Kim Dokja, it would be natural for an ordinary incarnation to go crazy.

"Then why does Anna think that Demon King is the 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

"Because I said so."

"Why did you lie like that?"

"That..."

"And according to Anna's story, the people in the Washington Dome also mentioned the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

Christina bit her chapped lip. She rolled her eyes back and forth as if she was looking at me, and it seemed like she had decided that there was no answer other than to be honest.

She said, "I need a little explanation to tell that story."

"Say it as briefly as possible."

"I didn't intend for things to turn out like this from the beginning. I had no intention of ruining the scenario this much."

Christina protested.

Hearing her speak, it seemed to me that Christina had not made the situation worse through malice.

And it was the same for other American apostles.

「"In times like this, you have to catch bugs. Everyone, look for bugs."」

「"Protect your children first. If we fight together, we can kill even the monster species!"」

「"We must not fight each other! We must all solve the scenario together!"」

The initial situation in the United States was not that different from Korea.

The problem started right after the first scenario ended.

「"Now… what should I do next?"」

American readers had little advantage from the start.

There was no guarantee that the American scenario would be the same as the Korean one, and even if it were the same, it would have been difficult to take advantage of the geographical advantage.

Even communication between the apostles was not smooth due to translation issues.

In such a situation, there was only one way the apostles chose to survive.

「"We must find Anna Croft."」

They eventually found Anna Croft and rallied around her.

After they met the main character, Anna, they thought maybe they could survive.

That was until they found out the identity of this world.

「"Oh my god, I don't think 'Kim Dokja' is here."」

The point is that this world is not 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

This world is the 41st round of 'Ways of Survival'.

It was a world where 'Kim Dokja' could never exist.

The apostles were overcome with great despair. Some began to believe in the apocalypse, while others let go of the scenario or ended their lives, saying they were destined to die anyway.

In the meantime, Christina and a few apostles fought steadfastly to help Anna Croft.

They cleared the second, third, and fourth scenarios with amazing results.

And they got some items as a reward.

"Disaster option."

They were given the opportunity to choose the 'disaster' that would come to them in the fifth scenario.

Normally, it would have been better to choose 'Kronos' there.

Because the disaster of Kronos was a disaster they were familiar with.

But then someone had an idea.

Couldn’t the 'disaster' here summon someone they know?

"Wait a minute, no way."

Just as Disaster of Floods Shin Yoosung did, some 'disasters' come from beyond this world line.

Then.

Christina lowered her head as if she had been shamed.

"Yes. We asked to summon the 'Demon King of Salvation' as the 'Disaster'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 701 Episode 25 Demon King (4)

Christina pursed her lips and continued speaking.

"I had to make decisions quickly," she said. "Too many people died before we even got to the fifth scenario."

How did she manage to get to the fifth scenario?

However, the apostles who knew the ending of this story knew that if the scenarios continued like this, everything would go wrong.

The ultimate resolution of the scenarios were impossible in this world line where Kim Dokja does not exist.

No matter how well they clear the previous scenarios, they will end up frustrated in front of the 'Final Wall'.

So they decided to take a risk in the fifth scenario.

Summoning the 'Demon King of Salvation' with the 'Disaster Summoning Rights'.

Even if it was called crazy, it was a choice that I had nothing to say about.

"What were you going to do if you failed?"

"That..."

"Besides, even if you succeed, it’s still a problem."

If the 'Demon King of Salvation' had been summoned as a disaster, something truly absurd could have happened.

Nevertheless, I could not find fault with the readers’ heart for looking for Kim Dokja at the most desperate moment.

Maybe it's because I too had a similar experience like them.

「"I will sign a contract behind the scenes."」

Just like searching for God, anyone who knows Kim Dokja's name has no choice but to find him.

This is probably the same for all readers who came to this world.

I asked, looking down at Anna Croft, who was sleeping soundly on Christina's lap.

"She was [hypnotized], so Anna doesn’t know the details of the situation."

"Yes..."

Anna Croft is the most cautious character in 'Ways of Survival'.

There is no way she would suddenly agree to summoning a being that she has never heard of or seen, the 'Demon King of Salvation', as a disaster.

In the end, Christina and the apostles hypnotized Anna and they secretly summoned the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

In return, the 'Washington Dome' became a demon realm.

"At first, we were planning to do whatever we could to stop it. We gathered all the apostles in America and headed to the Washington Dome. That happened a few weeks ago."

It would not have been possible to honestly say that Washington was destroyed because of their choices.

To make up for their mistakes, the apostles attempted to attack the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"You failed."

"…Yes."

"Is that why you brought me here?"

"I'm ashamed."

Christina must have thought the moment she confirmed my sponsor.

The 'Demon King of Salvation' they were looking for was already in this world line, and maybe that's why their 'summoning' failed.

"Is there really a 'Demon King of Salvation' in this world? Is there a 'Kim Dokja' we know?"

Is there a 'Kim Dokja' they know in this world?

I thought for a moment and answered like this.

"There is a friend who is much more real than the 'Demon King of Salvation' over there. What on earth is the 'Demon King of Salvation' over there?"

"I don't know. What's certain is that he wasn't the 'Demon King of Salvation' that we know. And…"

"And?"

"The Demon King continued to grow stronger every time the apostles visited."

Did he continue to get stronger every time the apostles visited him?

There was a theory that came to mind, but I wasn't sure yet.

But I have one person who can confirm all these hypotheses.

'Kim-ssi.'

This guy said he was going to exchange coins, but where on earth did he go?

At that moment, with a chirping sound, 'Midday Tryst' was reconnected.

'No, where did you go and why are you coming back only now?'

—Youngest, I’m in big trouble.

'A big problem happened here too.'

I was trying to explain what incredible things have happened while he was away.

However,

—I think my modifier was stolen.

It seemed like something really big had happened over there too.

---

Everything in the <Star Stream> is a 'story', that is, a 'tale'.

However, since the concept of 'tale' seemed so abstract, 'currency', a practical processing of it, appeared.

This is the story of the 'coin' we know.

—Constellations spend coins just by breathing.

'Do Constellations need to breathe?'

—It means that coins are consumed just by existing.

'I know, but I didn't know that it costs money to maintain a modifier.'

Since Kim Dokja never mentioned it once, I never thought about it either.

I never thought it would cost coins just by using a modifier. Is that why the Constellations have always been keen on earning coins?

'But are you saying that your Constellation modifier has been taken away?'

—Not the Constellation modifier.

'what do you mean then?'

—I also have a Demon King modifier.

According to Kim Dokja's claim, Constellations that suddenly came from other 'world lines' like Kim Dokja had to pay additional fees to use the <Star Stream> system.

However, Kim Dokja was both a 'Constellation' and a Demon King, so the cost of maintaining the modifier was doubled.

'How did you maintain the Constellation modifier, but you couldn’t pay the cost of maintaining the Demon King modifier?'

I wondered why this person was so obsessed with 'coins'…

—I was thinking of exchanging some of the story fragments and monster parts I got this time and buying the modifier again... but the Management Bureau had already sold off my Demon King modifier.

Suddenly I felt like I knew how things were going.

I briefly explained to Kim Dokja about the events that occurred in the United States.

When he heard the story about the apostles of the American continent and the 'right to summon disaster', Kim Dokja let out a sigh.

—Oh, that was the spam message from the Management Bureau. They said it was a disaster blah blah blah.

It looks like he didn't even read the Management Bureau's message.

'Then the Demon King of Salvation who is currently in Washington...'

—It’s probably the new 'Demon King of Salvation' that the Management Bureau has found.

'This is the guy who bought the Demon King's nickname.'

In other words, the 'Demon King of Salvation' currently in Washington is a counterfeit, 'Demon King of Salvation' in name only.

'Is he also a 'Demon King'?'

—It won’t be at the level of a Demon King. Because they have a lot of pride, they don't steal and use other people's modifiers. He's probably a demon trying to use this opportunity to ascend to the throne of the Demon King.

No matter what the guy's identity was, for now I had no choice but to head to Washington.

I had Christina wake Anna up and explain what was needed. Anna Croft looked very embarrassed, but she quickly calmly accepted the situation.

"I'm angry, but I can't help it. I'll take strict action for this later, Christina."

"I'm sorry, Anna."

"Please swear an [Oath of Existence]. You will never [Hypnotize] me again."

"I swear."

Anna did not press Christina any further. Maybe it's because she knows that persecuting her now won't solve her situation.

Anna had her artisans bring the completed '4th grade Earth Dragon' equipment.

"You've caused trouble. Cheon Inho, let's leave right away."

After completing preparations, we immediately opened the portal to the 'Washington Dome'.

As the situation got to this point, I too became confused.

Are my companions still safe?

What happened to Yoo Joonghyuk, who met a marquis-level demon species?

How strong is the 'Demon King of Salvation' in the Washington Dome?

The moment I sort out my complicated thoughts and stepped into the portal.

[Someone has killed the ruler of 'Washington East'.]

A message was heard.

---

The 'demon' had no name.

[You are a 7th grade demon species 'Dark Sentinel'.]

He, like most other demon species, existed only as a part of a scenario designed by Dokkaebis. Killing the incarnations that come to the 'Treasure Storehouse of the Earth

River Lord' and offering their souls to the Demon Kings.

The demon had no complaints about it. Just as gopher rats never question their breathing, breathing black ether, and collecting treasures, he also never once questioned his work.

The whole incident started with him killing some humans who were hiding in his 'treasure warehouse'.

「"It is the Keeper of Darkness!"」

「"It’s true. It’s just like the novel."」

He dealt with the incarnations as usual. Attack using tentacles.

But surprisingly, the duo skillfully repelled his attack.

「"Through! Kim Dokja's method works! Push on!"」

「"If you attack the left ankle, the upper right tentacle moves!"」

Not only did humans know his attack patterns, but they also used weapons with 'divine attributes' to which he was vulnerable.

He screamed every time his tentacles were cut.

「"It’s over! Finish it!"」

Looking back, if he had been an ordinary 'dark sentinel', he certainly would not have been able to withstand the attacks of that duo.

But the duo was unlucky.

The period of time he lived as a 'Dark Sentinel' was a little longer than other 'Dark Sentinels', and because of that, he was able to display a little more wisdom in battle than other entities.

When he pretended to be weak and stumbled, the humans attacked him with great force. He did not miss the gaps between the humans and radiated pitch-black darkness.

「"What? This is a pattern that didn’t exist before!"」

「"Novels didn’t originally show detailed patterns! Damn it, run away!"」

One of the duo was missed, but the other was caught in the tentacles and could not escape.

「"Save me! Please save me!"」

An obvious appeal that he had always heard.

The demon, not interested in human tears, lightly pierced the human's heart with its tentacle. The man who was crying and bleeding out died.

「It’s boring.」

The moment that thought occurred to him, he was surprised at himself.

「What is 'boredom'?」

It's a feeling he's never had before.

He suddenly lowered his head and looked down at the tip of his tentacle. There was a small doll statue that gave off a faint light.

An item he had never seen before while living as a demon.

As if he was possessed, he moved his tentacles and grabbed the doll, and countless emotions that he had never felt before came flooding back to him.

A very precious, sad, and nostalgic feeling. What followed was a very strong appetite.

He could not overcome his desire and eventually swallowed the doll.

"What is 'I'?"

That's how the demon recognized his existence for the first time.

"I am the 'keeper of darkness'."

No.

That is not an accurate expression.

"I am an 'extra'."

Even though he didn't really understand what 'extra' was, he felt the nuance of the word.

He wanted to know. What is this feeling?

[You have evolved into a 5th grade demon species, 'Dark Seeker'.]

He participated in the scenario and started hunting. He learned to fight from the humans who came to hunt him. He no longer fought like a 'Dark Sentinel'.

He used weapons and wore equipment possessed by humans.

「"Oh my god! It's a 5th grade demon!"」

「"There is no proper information about the Dark Seeker—"」

「"Run! Everyone run!"」

Just like that, one, two, three... killing people again and again.

And very occasionally, he could get something from particularly strong humans.

['Kim Dokja's Fragment' has been acquired.]

He didn't understand the meaning of the message, but he understood at least one thing.

The more of these 'fragments' he acquires, the stronger he becomes.

He began hunting humans at an increasingly faster rate. He became familiar with the habits of humans and learned their mannerisms.

He set traps targeting humans looking for hidden items, and even deliberately disguised himself as a weak monster species.

How many fragments could he have eaten that way?

When he came to his senses, he had already become a demon noble.

[You have evolved into a 'Demon Noble'.]

And that 'being' came to visit him.

[Wow, this is my first time seeing a devil like you.]

A group called 'Management Bureau' by the public.

[Don't you want to have a 'name'?]

The Dokkaebi from the Management Bureau asked and he nodded.

[If you give me all your Coins, I will give you a 'name'.]

He willingly paid with the coins he had collected after killing the incarnations.

[From now on, you are the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

That's how he became the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

When he actually heard it, he felt like it was a name that suited him very well. The stories boiling inside him were saying so.

「Collect the fragments.」

「Become the one and only 'Kim Dokja'.」

There was a feeling of elation welling up from deep within his soul.

He will become the 'Demon King' of this world. He will break away from being an 'extra' and become a ‘being’ who longs for the real ■ ■ .

However, as if laughing at his efforts,

"You’ve just ascended to the rank of marquis."

The real hero of this story came to visit him.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 702 Episode 25 Demon King (5)

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[Someone has killed the ruler of 'Washington Dome'.]

At first I couldn't understand the message.

"What happened?"

"Maybe... the King did it."

To put it simply, the situation was clear.

Yoo Joonghyuk defeated the 'Ruler of the Washington Dome'.

Otherwise, such a message would not have occurred to me.

We went straight into the 'Washington Dome' to confirm the facts.

A gray stream stained by the invasion of the Demon Realm.

Demon species and human corpses were scattered all over the streets.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

I shouted, but there was no answer. We quickly started running towards the Capitol.

Through the flowing scenery, I could guess what kind of fight my colleagues who came here first must have gone through.

"Dansu ahjussi! Sein-ssi!"

I kept calling people's names.

Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Killer King, Cha Yerin, Ye Hyunwoo.

Yoo Joonghyuk's colleagues Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, and Kim Namwoon. And...

"Yoosoung-ssi!"

Even though I shouted at the top of my lungs, there was no answer.

Washington was locked in a strangely deep silence. No sign of 'living things' could be detected anywhere.

"Anna Croft."

I glared at Anna.

Obviously she said that my colleagues were safe.

In fact she still maintained that opinion.

"The Korean group is safe."

"How can you guarantee that if you can’t even use [Future Sight]?"

"When Yoo Joonghyuk declared a head-on confrontation with the Marquis-class, all 'Korean members' except him moved to the 'next scenario'."

Next scenario?

"The Washington Dome scenario is the final part of the 'seventh scenario', but it is a kind of 'selection scenario'."

Anna Croft looked up at the sky over Washington as she said those words.

There was a swirling vortex in the sky, showing a faint light.

A half-broken rope ladder was seen swinging down the vortex.

['Star Ladder' has been created.]

[Incarnations that meet certain conditions can use the ladder.]

A certain fact came to mind belatedly.

Here on the American continent, the 'seventh scenario' and the 'eighth scenario' were currently underway together.

"As you probably know, incarnations who have hunted enough monsters can move on to the next scenario without having to clear this scenario."

In short, that ladder was the door leading to the 'eight scenario'.

"There is no way the other party members would have left Yoo Joonghyuk alone."

"It was the King's last command. He threatened to kill everyone if they didn't move on to the next scenario right away, so his companions had no choice but to listen."

If there had been a threat from Yoo Joonghyuk, it wouldn't have been surprising if the group had left first.

But why did Yoo Joonghyuk give such an 'order'?

—Did this kid try to monopolize the items by himself again?

'Is that really the reason?'

—How do you know if you haven't even read Ways of Survival?

'Even without reading Ways of Survival, I know that much.'

While bickering with Kim Dokja, an additional message came to mind.

[You have completed the mission to subdue a 4th grade monster species.]

['Star Ladder' responds to you.]

[Would you like to use 'Star Ladder'?]

[You can enter the 'Eighth Scenario' area when using the ladder.]

Is it because the subjugation of the 4th grade species was completed in Korea? I also qualified to move to the eighth scenario.

By the way, that 'Star Ladder' is a device that I have never seen in the main story.

'Wasn't the original eighth scenario 'Dark Castle'?'

—Hmm...

Deep down, I thought it was a good thing. That's because 'Dark Castle' is one of the scenarios that boasts the worst difficulty level in all of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

It is the place where the 'Demon King of Salvation' was born, and a scenario where someone must 'sacrifice' themselves.

It was better to avoid it at all costs if possible.

However, our 'Ways of Survival expert' seemed to have a different opinion.

—If possible, don't use that ladder.

'Why?'

—If you are lucky, it may be a more comfortable scenario than 'Dark Castle', but if you are unlucky... you may end up in a place worse than 'Dark Castle'.

'They say my colleagues have already passed.'

—I hope those friends are lucky.

I was about to ask how someone could say such an irresponsible thing, but with a light spark, the connection to 'Midday Tryst' was temporarily disconnected.

If you look closely, it seems like this person does this on purpose whenever he is in trouble.

"Anyway, I guess the situation isn't that bad."

Anna Croft, whose expression became brighter, looked around and said.

"If it is true that the King defeated the Demon King, it is safe to say that the scenario has already ended. Excluding the core ruler of the dome, all that remains are henchmen."

As she said, the key to this situation was a 'marquis-level Demon King' in the Capitol.

However, if Yoo Joonghyuk had defeated him alone, this scenario should have been considered over.

[The seventh scenario is currently in progress.]

One ominous thing is that the scenario ending message is still not displayed.

It was clearly said that the 'ruler of the Washington Dome' had been killed.

So why hasn't the scenario ended yet?

It was then that Anna, who had been a few steps ahead, suddenly stopped.

"Cheon Inho."

A portal appeared opposite the building on the right. We were nervous and each took out our weapons and held them.

Could it be that another 'demon species' has appeared? Or not—

All right.

The light footsteps coming from beyond the portal were not human.

Next, a white horse with dazzling fur appeared, lightly touring, accompanied by a bright halo of light.

The knight on the horse lightly stroked the horse's head.

"Calm down Griffith."

Shiny silver chain mail and a red surcoat wrapped around the chain mail. At first glance, the man's bright blonde hair swaying in the wind made you guess that he came from a great family.

"Are you Anna Croft?"

Anna, who suddenly came to her senses at the knight's grave voice, asked back.

"Are you really Sir Elliot?"

"This is my first time seeing you in real life, Prophet."

The knight lightly got off his horse and approached with a gentle smile.

"As expected, you are just as beautiful as I saw in my dream."

Then he knelt down on one knee in front of Anna and held out his hand to her. It looked like he was trying to kiss her on the back of her hand.

But instead of giving the back of her hand, Anna looked down at the knight with expressionless eyes.

"Tell us the purpose of your visit, Sir Elliot."

The knight stood up with an embarrassed expression.

"It looks like the Lady is very angry. I came here to help my sister through her difficulties, but I am disappointed to receive such cold treatment."

Only then did I feel like I knew how the story was going.

—That's one of Britain's representative incarnations.

Kim Dokja, who only appears when he has something to say, appeared again this time without fail.

'Who is it?'

—Him? Elliott Haston.

'So who is that?'

—Have you ever heard of the Knights of the Round Table?

I was startled and looked at the man's clothes again. The man who looked like he was cosplaying as a knight had a pattern drawn on his coat that I had seen before somewhere.

[The Constellation 'Knight of the Lake' is proud of his incarnation.]

Knight of the Lake.

Only then did I realize who the man was.

'Could it be the incarnation of 'Lancelot'?'

—That’s right.

Lancelot, one of King Arthur's knights.

It was a famous Constellation in Korea as well.

'But wasn’t Lancelot originally born in France? He chose a British incarnation.'

—Oh, you know that too?

Of course I know. Even after all this, I am a writer.

As far as I know, Lancelot was a fictional character created in France while reinterpreting the 'Legend of King Arthur'.

—Because a French Constellation does not necessarily have a French person as its incarnation. Neither Jecheon Daeseong nor Uriel are Constellations from Korea.

'Of course, that's true.'

We checked Elliot’s condition through [Character List].

| |
|---|
| Chivalry, Advanced applied swordsmanship, Equestrianism, Position defense... |

The proficiency level of all skills was very high. All of their overall abilities are at or above Korea's 'King' level.

—Courner 'Griffith'. He even managed to save a rare species of spirit creature.

Hee hee hee, the crying horse snorted at me.

A great powerhouse with expensive equipment and means of transportation.

It would have been nice to welcome such a great force coming to help, but Anna Croft didn’t look happy.

"I asked for help three times, but there was no response."

"Haha, Prophet. Of course we wanted to help too, but..."

It seems that the UK has consistently rejected requests for support.

It is understandable that support will be difficult for any country at this point.

But the problem is this.

Why did the UK accept the request for support now?

To put it simply, it could be because there is more room in their country's scenario.

—That can’t be possible.

Regardless of country, all incarnations of the destroyed world are selfish.

Their only motivation is survival, so they are naturally reluctant to do anything that poses a threat to their survival.

Nevertheless, if they moved, it meant that there was a reason to take that risk this time.

"Who is this person?"

When Elliot's eyes turned to me, Anna answered on my behalf.

"This is Cheon Inho from Korea."

"South or North?"

"It’s south."

"Hmm."

Elliot looked at me with a strange gaze as Anna explained.

A look that seems to be evaluating the breed of horse. Then he quickly smiled and turned his head.

'Constellation-nim.'

—This is a person that will soon be beaten by Joonghyuk.

'Huh?'

One after another, portals appeared on the other side.

"Is this Washington?"

"It’s a city with nothing special about it."

Incarnations of different races.

It seems that not only the UK but also other countries participated in this scenario.

Among them were some faces I recognized.

"Sister Ren, did we come to the right place?"

"Well, according to the coordinates, this is the right place."

'Asuka Ren', the incarnation of Miyamoto Musashi, and his fellow incarnations.

These were the incarnations that cleared the scenario together with Kim Dokja in 'Peace Land' in Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

Unfortunately, the 41st round of 'Peace Land' took place while I was passed out, and I had no connection with them.

In the back portal, a large number of Chinese incarnations appeared.

I looked at the Chinese who took the lead and asked Kim Dokja.

'Is that Fei Hu?'

—No, I don't think Fei Hu came.

Fei Hu is the representative incarnation of the Chinese Nebula, <Emperor>.

His face was not visible as he was busy participating in the mainland's scenario.

—Still, it's not easy to get together like this in the beginning, but it's quite a unique scene.

Although there were no famous incarnations like China's Fei Hu or India's Ranbir Khan, the sight of incarnations from all over the world gathered together was spectacular in its own way.

"Ren-san. You're here?"

"Prophet."

Asuka Ren and Anna exchanged warm greetings, probably because they were already familiar with each other.

"Who is this person…?"

"This is Cheon Inho-ssi. He came from Korea to help us."

"Korea! Is this the King’s group?"

Asuka Ren bowed to me as if she was happy to see me.

"I am Asuka Ren."

"I am Cheon Inho."

"It’s a pleasure to meet you, Cheon Inho-san. I received a lot of help from the Korean incarnations in the last scenario. How is Killer King?"

Was 'Killer King' among the many incarnations there?

I was about to ask what Killer King had done there, when a gruff voice came from behind.

"Prophet! Where is the 'Demon King in Washington' you spoke of?"

An incarnation whose country was difficult to guess from their appearance.

At the same time, the murmurs around me disappeared all at once.

That made it clear.

They have all come to kill the 'ruler of Washington East'.

"The Demon King has already been caught."

Anna Croft's answer made the incarnations stir.

"That can’t be possible. We came here with a scenario."

Scenario?

"A sub-scenario has been sent to eliminate the disaster in Washington."

It was a word that gave me an uncomfortable feeling.

Did they receive a 'sub-scenario' instead of a main scenario?

"The disaster has already been eliminated. We have just received the message."

Even with Anna Croft's explanation, the incarnations' excitement did not seem to subside.

"That can’t be possible. There’s a scenario like this out there!"

"Do they want to monopolize compensation in the United States?"

"We don’t have time, so stop talking nonsense and give me directions quickly! Where is the Demon King?"

"I came here to help as much as I could, but the Americans don’t even know how to thank me."

What happened?

Anna Croft and I looked at each other without understanding what was going on, and then we saw Christina, who had gone exploring nearby, come back in a huff.

"Anna. Something’s wrong. The invasion zone hasn’t been lifted yet."

When the hunt for 'Disaster' ends, the planetary invasion automatically ends.

But Washington was still gray.

The land is deeply polluted by the 'roots of darkness' that have spread everywhere.

[The 'seventh scenario' is currently in progress.]

A scenario that still doesn't end.

At that moment, a pitch-black light rose from the distant Capitol.

"That’s—"

Even though no one told them to, the incarnations ran towards that direction at the same time.

Eliot, the Chinese incarnations, Asuka Ren was also riding a skateboard and riding away.

Anna and I exchanged glances and then ran after them.

How long did we run like that?

We soon arrived at the Capitol in question.

Someone was sitting on top of the Capitol building, stained with hazy smoke.

Elliot muttered.

"That’s the 'Demon King in Washington'."

What was there was not a human figure.

A beast reminiscent of a pitch-black wolf.

An ominous aura felt from the black hair growing all over its body.

As its golden eyes slowly looked around, several incarnations screamed.

An overwhelming feeling that makes you feel suffocated just by looking at it.

"Ah, Demon King—"

"All armies ready for battle!"

"We’ll hunt the Demon King!"

While everyone was frightened and took out their weapons, I stared blankly at the monster.

For some reason I couldn't take my eyes off that monster.

'Constellation-nim.'

Because.

—Damn, I guess that’s true.

No matter how I look at it, in my eyes,

'Yes?'

Because that 'Black Beast' looked like Yoo Joonghyuk.

[A new scenario has arrived!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 703 Episode 25 Demon King (6)

A Black Beast looking down on Washington City with vague eyes.

Other people might not have noticed, but I couldn't not recognize that guy.

Without a doubt, that guy is Yoo Joonghyuk.

[Check the 'new sub-scenario'.]

**<Sub Scenario – Beast Hunting>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: ???

Clear conditions: Defeat the 'Black Beast' that rules Washington City.

Time Limit: —

Reward: narrative grade story, 300,000 coins, S grade skill selection, ???

Failure: —

What on earth is going on?

Clearly, what I had come to exorcise was the 'ruler of the Washington Dome'. But why did a scenario to exorcise Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly arrive?

'Constellation-nim?'

But Kim Dokja had no answer.

Instead, I heard a faint voice in my head.

—Constellation. So, how did this happen...

A voice of non-formality.

Meanwhile, Kim Dokja seemed to be questioning Bihyung about the scenario.

—This wasn't our intention... It's true that we sold the Constellation's modifier, but…

It seems that this scenario was not Bihyung's intention.

Anyway, the situation was bad.

Slowly, the eyes of the incarnations were changing.

"Hey. Did you check the reward?"

"Uh."

"If I do this well, I will make a fortune."

The incarnations that were initially afraid of the Black Beast were returning to the vicinity of the Capitol one by one.

300,000 coins and a narrative grade story.

Plus, you can even select S grade skills.

It was a reward that could never be received in an ordinary 'sub-scenario'.

—Youngest. From now on, listen to me carefully.

Kim Dokja returned just in time and spoke to me.

—That bastard has now activated two 'Story Imprints'.

'What exactly is a story imprint?'

Since 'engraving a tale' was a setting that did not appear in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint,' I calmly listened to Kim Dokja's explanation.

According to Kim Dokja's words, there were a total of three 'Story Imprints' engraved on Yoo Joonghyuk's body.

「Redemption of truth」

「Restraint of Emotions」

「Redemption of Life」

—'Redemption of Truth' is a power that can be used at the cost of some of the memories of the past. Ordinary people would turn into idiots if they abused it, but for that guy who still has memories, it's not a big burden.

I had also heard about the first story imprint from Anna Croft.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who activated that imprint, slaughtered four viscount-level demons at once.

The problem was the second story imprint.

—'Emotional restraint' is the imprint of paying a price for one's emotions. If you use that imprint, you will gradually lose your identity as a human being. As if it were…

'It means becoming an animal.'

—Yes.

Could it be that that's why Yoo Joonghyuk turned into a beast?

—But usually, using 'emotional restraint' does not lead to 'beastization' to that extent. At most, your arms or legs will turn into a beast. But that bastard has now become a complete beast, and his physical level has risen several levels.

'I think I just found a clue.'

Small sparkling debris on the floor near the Capitol.

—Catch it! Hurry!

I walked quickly and bent down to catch the fragments.

[A very small 'Kim Dokja Fragment' was obtained.]

[The fragment is too small to be recognized as 'loss'.]

[Legendary story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' looks dissatisfied and eats the fragment.]

[Your lifespan increases.]

[5 minute time limit has been added.]

Although it is slight, lifespan has increased.

And.

「…」

A story began to be told.

It was the story of a demon.

A demon who was born as a guardian of darkness and evolved by collecting 'Fragments of Kim Dokja'. A memory of a being who just wanted to escape from being an extra.

"You'll die here."

「[Incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk' activates 'Binding of Truth'!]」

Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round was surprisingly strong.

A level of combat power equivalent to that of a 'marquis-level demon'. The two, who had engaged in over 100 exchanges in an instant, caught their breath and explored each other's gaps.

Scratch, tear, cut, stab.

As the wounds on his entire body increased, the demon shrank little by little.

He thought he was strong enough.

He killed and ate many humans, took their power.

But what on earth is this 'human'?

「"After all, just one engraving is enough. It wasn’t the power to use here, but…"」

As Yoo Joonghyuk muttered that, his whole body was covered in pitch-black light.

「[Incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk' activates 'Emotional Restraint'!]」

Finally, Yoo Joonghyuk's second story imprint was activated.

Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body began to be covered with black fur. His chest and thighs swelled, veins protruded, and his rough muscles twitched.

After that, the demon's memory was partially damaged. A scene where something pitch-black is running. A scene where the body is cut, torn, and eaten.

Only emotions stained with fear and horror were concentrated in the fragments.

「The demon had bad luck. Because the person he met was the 'king'.」

The torn apart demon stretched out his hands with all his might, as if begging for his life. It was something he had learned from the countless people he had killed.

「The demon was lucky. Because the last person he met was 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.」

If it were an ordinary Yoo Joonghyuk, he would not have held the demon's hand.

However, at that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk had activated two 'Story Imprints'.

Part of his memory was controlled due to the 'Restraint of Truth', and part of his reason was paralyzed due to the 'Restraint of Emotions'.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had only instinct left, stretched out his hand as if possessed the moment he saw the shining fragment at the demon's fingertips.

「Fragment of Kim Dokja.」

Yoo Joonghyuk's hand touched the fragment, and Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes became blurred.

As his soul wavered, a gap appeared in [Sage's Eyes] and his [Mental Barrier] was disturbed.

The demon did not miss his last chance.

「The demon finally got a chance to become the main character of this story.」

Goosebumps ran down my spine.

I reflexively muttered to Yoo Joonghyuk, who was standing above the Capitol.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Then the Black Beast looked down at me. It wasn't a look that recognized me.

"Demon."

A Black Beast left with only deep distrust and hatred towards the world.

The beast let out a long roar at Washington.

Several incarnations fainted and fell to the ground at the howling that seemed to shake their souls.

However, there were also some who were more motivated.

"Kill him! We'll have the reward!"

The first to step forward was a group of incarnations from the Middle East.

Wearing old combat uniforms and caps, they immediately grabbed their guns and started firing.

"Shoot!"

As magic bullets reminiscent of [Gangmashi] formed a fire net, the entire Capitol was soon filled with pale dust.

"Wait a minute! Stop! Stop!"

I shouted as I ran toward them. Of course, it wasn't Yoo Joonghyuk that I was worried about.

"Kwaaaaaak."

Blood splashing through the pale dust. The incarnations with only their lower bodies remaining collapsed like dolls.

—Fuck, Youngest.

'The demon is now in Yoo Joonghyuk, right?'

—Yes.

'Do I need an exorcism?'

—The Vatican guys didn’t come. And any exorcist can’t do. That demon is also at the 'Marquis' level.

'Are you sure?'

—You have to remove the Story Imprint first.

So, the moment I asked how to do that.

[There are special clear conditions in this 'sub-scenario'.]

A scenario message appeared before my eyes.

> 1. In order to exterminate the ‘Black Beast’, you must remove the 'eight fragments' stuck on the beast’s back.
>
> 2. You can receive great rewards when you consecrate the successfully removed fragments to the Nebula.

It was obvious what the eight fragments that sprouted from Yoo Joonghyuk's back were.

'Fragment of Kim Dokja.'

I remembered the 4th grade Earth Dragon, who possessed abnormal strength.

The Earth Dragon, which absorbed only one fragment, was also '4th grade', so how strong is Yoo Joonghyuk, who absorbed eight?

At that moment, the beast's golden eyes turned in this direction.

To be precise, he was not looking at me, but at the woman next to me.

「The demon felt an unknown killing intent.」

It was almost simultaneously that I looked back at her and the beast disappeared.

That 'Black Beast' had its reason removed and only instinct remained.

"Anna!"

And right now, the person next to me was Yoo Joonghyuk's most hated enemy.

In an instant, the beast's front paw lunged right in front of her, aiming for Anna's head. The moment Anna, with her eyes wide open, took a step back, the king's guardian who had been waiting behind her moved.

"Goddess!"

The 'Shield of Aegis' was summoned from the back of Selena Kim’s hand.

In the 3rd round, Selena Kim received the blessings of the goddess Athena.

Perhaps she received her sacred relic as a gift this time too.

Quaaaaaaaaa!

The 'Shield of Aegis' collided with Yoo Joonghyuk’s front foot.

A relic of a legendary Constellation.

And Selena Kim, who uses holy relics, was a powerhouse in the '100 strongest people in Ways of Survival' as time passed.

She couldn't withstand the single blow and fell dozens of meters.

Selena Kim exclaimed, standing up unsteadily as if one of her knees had been broken.

"Anna, run…!"

"Stand back, Prophet!"

The one who ran bravely after her was Elliot Haston, the incarnation of Lancelot.

Eliot drew his sword, scattering pure white light, and galloped away on his own horse, Griffith.

I also saw a dozen knights following him.

"Constellations of the Round Table!"

[At the request of incarnation 'Elliot Haston', 'Round Table Justice' is activated!]

[The 'Round Table Council' is convened.]

Round Table Council.

I asked with wide eyes.

'Constellation-nim, is that—'

—Wow, this is my first time seeing that too.

Just like the 'Judge of Destruction' activates [Time of Judgment] with the consent of Constellations from the 'Absolute Good', the 'Knights of the Round Table' can activate [Justice of the Round Table] with the consent of the 'Round Table Council'.

['Round Table Council' agrees to activate the skill.]

[The incarnation 'Elliot Haston' activates 'Round Table Justice'!]

The spirit of the great round table surged from Elliot Haston's entire body.

As if responding to their spirit, a dazzling brilliance flowed from the knights' bodies.

"Kill the monster!"

The knights in a wedge formation fiercely charged towards Yoo Joonghyuk. For a moment, I thought that it might be able to cause damage.

And explosive magical power surged from the Black Beast's whole body. The magic power contained in the beast's paws soon poured towards the knights like a cannonball.

「Breaking the Sky technique.」

Screams and moans coming from everywhere.

As the thick dust cleared, the horrors of the battlefield were fully revealed. Throughout the Capitol, knights with torn limbs were hanging out like dolls.

It was messy.

"Uh, how—"

Elliot also had a small hole in his stomach and was vomiting blood.

Even the powerful Knights of the Round Table could not subdue Yoo Joonghyuk.

In my head, I heard the sound of Kim Dokja clicking his tongue.

—You can’t beat that one. It's better to just withdraw. The current Yoo Joonghyuk cannot be stopped even by Fei Hu and Ranbir Khan.

When Kim Dokja said that, a faint feeling of guilt came over me.

Because I felt like maybe all of this was because of me.

「"Stop it."」

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk knew that he would end up like that, and that's why he tried to take me with him.

「"I don’t really know why, but when I receive that memory, I stop acting."」

I bit my lip.

'There is still a way.'

The reason Yoo Joonghyuk's mind was shaken was because of the memory of the 'Kim Dokja fragment'.

So what if I shake his head vigorously again?

So to speak, if you get hit in the back of the head with a very powerful memory.

'Constellation-nim. Possess me again.'

Unfortunately, it was something I couldn't do on my own.

—No.

'Why?'

—The cooldown hasn’t started. And there aren't enough coins to pay for the probability.

'I’ll pay for the coins. How much cooldown time is left?'

—10 minutes.

My mind felt dizzy.

In 10 minutes, it would not be surprising if the entire Washington area was devastated and all incarnations here were annihilated.

I looked back at Anna.

There is no choice. From here, we have no choice but to withdraw and look for another opportunity—

"Cheon Inho."

But Anna’s eyes looked strange. She was spinning with an ominous glow in her eyes. Sparks bouncing wildly.

I realized what was happening.

"Can you see the future?"

"He’s coming."

Anna's voice was embarrassed.

Before I could ask who was coming, I saw a portal swirling in the distance.

Haven't all the incarnations that were worthy of coming have already come?

In any case, no matter what incarnation came here, they would just die.

Even if Fei Hu and Ranbir Khan come, the situation will not change even if someone comes to a situation that cannot be stopped.

Eventually, what appeared beyond the portal was the front paw of a huge animal.

Coo coo coo coo.

Incarnations riding on monsters resembling elephants.

Are they Indian incarnations? Could it be that Ranbir Khan has come?

The sound of laughter coming from somewhere.

The moment I saw incarnations occupying the center of the line, something suddenly popped into my head.

"Hahaha! Yoo Joonghyuk! I’m here!"

Why had I forgotten his existence?

I remembered the 'seventh scenario' from the 3rd round.

In the original third round, Seoul was occupied by a religious denomination.

But this time, I didn't hear any particular news, so I wondered if the 'church' had disappeared as the scenario changed.

It was a complacent thought.

—Oh, maybe.

He was the only incarnation who defeated the 'King' in the 3rd round.

A beautiful man with his arms wide open like a lotus flower in full bloom spoke to Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You look great, Yoo Joonghyuk."

The leader of the Salvation Church, Nirvana Moebius, has arrived in Washington.

"But why are you becoming one with a being other than myself?"

Perhaps a little angry.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 704 Episode 25 Demon King (7)

Nirvana Moebius.

A 'Reincarnator' with the Constellation 'Guardian of Mandala' as his sponsor.

Like Anna Croft, they are a being who can preserve a certain amount of memory by resisting Yoo Joonghyuk's [Regression].

They are the leader of the Salvation Church and was the 'counter' of Yoo Joonghyuk in the 3rd round.

"Only live in the present!"

They stomped their feet as the elephant bells thumped, accompanied by the cries of the Salvationists.

"There is no salvation in the afterlife!"

"What's important is now!"

"What must be liberated is 'today'!"

As the ground vibrated like a giant drum, the incarnations of the area shook loudly.

"W-what is it?"

"Salvation Church? Dammit, they came?"

Some of the incarnations were already aware of their existence, as some of them were preparing to withdraw the moment they saw the elephant monster.

"I'm falling for it. I shouldn't get involved with those crazy people."

However, there were still some incarnations who remained and watched.

Those who do not yet know much about the Salvation Church or are confident in their own abilities.

"Nirvana, the leader of the Salvation Church."

"Oh, Prophet?"

As Nirvana waved their hand happily, Anna Croft frowned and averted her gaze.

Nirvana slowly approached us and opened their mouth.

"Why did my Yoo Joonghyuk end up like that? Was it your fault?"

"The King is not yours."

"Answer me. What is that Demon King who is entangled with my Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"It's none of your business."

"If I don't care, who would care?"

Nirvana declared, spreading their arms wide.

"The relationship between me and Yoo Joonghyuk is connected by the wheel of eternity. You know because you secretly stole our story."

Anna Croft turned away from Nirvana and glanced towards me.

—Cheon Inho. You never met Nirvana in the last round, right?

It was [Transmission].

This is probably because she was wary of the existence of Nirvana.

It wasn't strange.

In this world, the only incarnations that know of Yoo Joonghyuk's [Regressions] from the beginning are Anna Croft, who can use [Future Sight], and the reincarnated Nirvana.

Therefore, the Prophet and the Reincarnator have no choice but to be endlessly wary of each other over Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Why are you making such a fuss?"

In an instant, Nirvana came right in front of her and suddenly stuck out their head.

Also a Reincarnator. Did they notice even the use of [Transmission]?

The guy glared at Anna and craned their long neck to ask.

"Who is this guy? Prophet, is this your new toy?"

My face was captured in the guy's eyes that were shining with pure white light.

"Why are you closing your eyes? Are you saying you don’t dare look at me?"

The moment I was about to reply that I had been watching, their right arm moved directly towards my forehead.

「Relationship story.」

I also knew that skill. A skill to read the other person's memories by weaving the bonds of stories with the power of the mandala.

But someone blocked their movements.

Quaaaaaaaaa!

Yoo Joonghyuk's fist flew in an instant and exploded into the guy's face.

Nirvana, who had rolled dozens of times against their will, shouted while holding one side of their face.

"Kaaaa! What are you doing, Yoo Joonghyuk!"

A blow that would have exploded the head of a normal incarnation.

However, in this round, Nirvana appears to have steadily increased his stamina and did not die even after being hit by Yoo Joonghyuk, who had become a beast.

Nirvana, with black bruises on their face, cried out again as if they were aggrieved.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Of course, Yoo Joonghyuk, unable to communicate, just growled and cried.

"Where on earth are you looking? Look at me in front of you!"

Enraged, Nirvana's hands began to move brilliantly.

This guy's signature technique was activated.

[The incarnation 'Nirvana Moebius' activates 'Thousand-Armed Guanyin Lv.8'!]

A dazzlingly rotating mandala settled behind the creature, and soon a thousand arms poured out like a waterfall around the mandala.

"Look at me! Me! Look at me!"

As the palms of Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara poured out and hit Yoo Joonghyuk’s head repeatedly, the beast's body began to sink to the ground little by little.

"Oh, that’s—"

"Is there also the leader of the Salvation Church?"

"We too are joining!"

I don't know how strong Nirvana will be when they grow up to the later scenarios.

In the main story, while fighting against Kim Dokja, Nirvana was absorbed by the [Fourth Wall] and became a librarian at the library.

But this world's Nirvana will never be absorbed by the [Fourth Wall].

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is glaring at incarnation 'Nirvana Moebius'.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' twitches his lips, saying that this incarnation is arrogant.]

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is concerned about your safety.]

A [Reincarnator] that does not die even if they die.

[Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara] that overwhelms even Yoo Joonghyuk, who used [Gigantification.]

In addition, there are mental abilities including [100 Torments] and [Eternal Nightmare].

Even Yoo Joonghyuk, no matter how much of a beast he has become, might not be able to deal with the current Nirvana.

"W-what!"

I thought so.

"He’s coming up!"

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been nailed to the ground by the blow of [Thousand-handed Avalokitesvara], began to stick his head out of the hole little by little.

Quad deud deuk!

A spear was held in the hands of Yoo Joonghyuk, who finally stuck his head out, pushing up his body with his paws, little by little.

Nirvana's eyes widened.

"Yoo Jong—"

Yoo Joonghyuk has lost his reason and only his instincts remain. Nevertheless, he was still a disciple of Breaking the Sky Saint.

I don't know about other people, but only Kim Dokja and I could recognize the skill.

[Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.]

A sword technique created to tear apart the Constellations of this world.

The swordsmanship extended into the sky.

"Yuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuuck—!"

Nirvana's [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara] was torn apart by a blow that felt like a black lightning strike.

The power that comes from pure differences in 'level'.

The sky made of palms shattered, and the beast holding the spear let out a harsh cry toward the sky.

Nirvana, spilling his blood, rolled around on the floor with half of their upper body blown away.

I was almost daunted by the incredible scenery.

'Shall we run away?'

Does it make sense that that is just an incarnation of the 'seventh scenario'?

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

Sparks of probability began to rush through Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body.

But no matter how much he becomes the prey of a 'sub-scenario', the strength that exceeds the probability limit of the scenario cannot be sustained for a long period of time. If things continue like this, it won't be long before Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body is burned by the aftermath.

—Well.

But Kim Dokja didn't seem to think so.

—The balance of probabilities is not only determined through aftermath.

Before I could ask what that meant, Nirvana, who was thought to be dead, suddenly stood up.

[The incarnation 'Nirvana Moebius' activates 'Possession Lv.4'!.]

After all, a Reincarnator is a Reincarnator.

In an instant, Nirvana's upper body, engulfed in lotus, began to regenerate rapidly.

By reviving part of their own story, their physical defects were restored.

Nearby, incarnations staggered and crawled towards Nirvana. They were the 'Salvationists' who followed them.

"Sect leader, I offer you my story."

"My story..."

Salvationists who suffered from [Thought Infection] volunteered to become sacrifices for the recovery of Nirvana.

Nirvana, lightly holding their hands, nodded their head.

"I will remember your story."

That was the identity of the Salvation Church.

All believers are merely pawns to complete the 'ultimate story' pursued by Nirvana.

Nirvana, having regained their strength, took a deep breath and opened their mouth.

"You are really strong in this round. It will be more rewarding to become one."

"..."

"I'm already looking forward to seeing what amazing stories you've built up... Wait a minute! Aren't I speaking to you! Kaaaaaaah!"

I asked Kim Dokja as I saw Nirvana starting to get beaten up as soon as they recovered.

'How much time is left now? They won't be able to last much longer.'

—5 minutes.

Nirvana, who was blocking Yoo Joonghyuk's attack by spreading the palm of the [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara], shouted.

"Prophet! What are you doing? Help me quickly!"

"How can I help you?"

"I, become one with Yoo Joonghyuk— keaaaaaa!"

"Even if I die, I won't become one with you!"

"Actually, I have no desire to become one with you!"

Nirvana, who had been hit dozens more times in that short period of time, said as their blood flowed.

"I don’t think that’s possible. I don’t want to further damage the body that will become one with me."

"Wait a minute! Nirvana, you—"

At the same time, the dark power of the story flowed from Nirvana's whole body.

—Looks like that bastard will end up using it.

Kim Dokja already seemed to know what technique he would use.

Of course, so did I and Anna Croft.

"Cheon Inho. We must stop it. The Reincarnator will use [Eternal Nightmare]."

[Eternal Nightmare.]

In the 3rd round in Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint, Yoo Joonghyuk fell victim to that technique.

"Right now, Yoo Joonghyuk has activated two story imprints and is in a state of insanity. In such a situation, if he were to receive that stigmata—"

"He’ll go crazy."

"I know. If we don’t stop it now—"

But even before we could move, Nirvana’s skill was already activated.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. I don’t know why you looked like that."

The nightmare of eons resided in the white-stained fingertips of this guy.

"It doesn’t matter what you look like now. I can be anything. Man, woman, animal, monster! Only I can understand your eternity!"

Nirvana's hand stretched out like a sword and touched Yoo Joonghyuk’s forehead.

"So you too will understand me."

And like magic, Yoo Joonghyuk’s movements stopped.

Nirvana became proud and burst into laughter.

"Hahahaha! Yoo Joonghyuk! Finally—"

Slowly, Yoo Joonghyuk’s eyes turned towards Nirvana.

"Yoo Jong—"

With a fluttering sound, one of Nirvana's arms flew through the air.

"Uh?"

The moment Nirvana made a stupid expression, their other arm also flew in the air.

"Kaaaaaaak!"

The pain came late. Nirvana, whose arms were torn off in an instant, let out a desperate scream.

Anna Croft, shocked, staggered back.

I said, sighing inwardly.

'As expected, it doesn't work for the current Yoo Joonghyuk.'

—Yes.

「Eternal Nightmare is a technique that brings up the opponent's most terrible memories and traps them in those memories.」

But what if the 'opponent' is a beast with only instinct left?

"Oh, how!"

For example, if your mind has become so stupid that you cannot recall any memories.

"Yoo Joonghyuk! Come to your senses! Your present—"

Nirvana's left leg was crushed with a loud sound.

"Kaaaaaaak!"

A spark of probability flew once again. An ecstatic Nirvana crawled on the floor on their haunches.

The Black Beast trampled on Nirvana's body and slowly looked around him.

King.

The man who suited that nickname better than anyone else cried out to the world.

And with that one howl, all the incarnations here realized.

[All incarnations of the 'Washington Dome' are terrified.]

No incarnation in the world can call itself 'king' in front of that monster.

[The scales of probability are moving.]

As long as it is 'incarnation'.

—Youngest.

I nodded.

Even though Yoo Joonghyuk is showing off such a powerful personality, the probability of the <Star Stream> did not stop him.

That said, the probability of this scenario is—

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated.]

It means allowing the emergence of a strong person to stop that 'Supreme King'.

[The third stage of 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is activated.]

Now it was the 'Demon King’s' turn to step forward.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 705 Episode 26 Star Ladder (1)

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With Yoo Joonghyuk's roar, the atmosphere of the battlefield changed. The frightened incarnations began to leave the battlefield one by one.

[Someone uses the 'Star Ladder'!]

[Someone uses the 'Star Ladder'!]

This scenario was a 'sub-scenario' and did not necessarily need to be cleared.

"Wait a minute, you guys—"

Because they didn't come here to protect Washington in the first place.

"I’m sorry, Prophet."

As the allies she trusted disappeared one by one, Anna Croft's expression became anxious.

The 'Star Ladder' in the sky continued to emit bright light.

"Anna."

Selena Kim and Christina stood by her side. Her colleagues also knew that there was no chance of victory at this rate.

Anna and Zarathustra's elites have already completed the subjugation of the 4 Grade Disaster Species. They could also use that Star Ladder if they wanted to.

Nevertheless, Anna did not leave the scenario.

If she abandons Washington, America will collapse. The invasion of the Demon World will continue and eventually hit Las Vegas.

As the representative of 'Zarathustra', she had a duty to protect this continent.

"Cheon Inho."

Anna Croft looked at me.

She was so desperate that she had to resort to her least favorite scammer.

"I will stop it. Instead—"

So, now was the only time for the scammer to set a 'condition'.

"Please lend me some of your skills."

"Which..."

"I know you have the 'Elixir Maker' trait."

The real reason I came to see Anna Croft.

I took out the ´Lesser Dragon Heart' from her arms. A reward obtained from defeating a 4th Grade Earth Dragon.

However, because the processing process for Dragon Heart is so complicated, there is currently only one way to refine it into an elixir.

"I need your blood."

It is to mix it with the blood of the 'Elixir Manufacturer'.

A startled Anna Croft stared at me closely and said.

"You know what happens if you drink my blood."

"I will become a member of your household."

I said this, recalling Kim Dokja from the Third Round, who was revived after drinking Anna's blood.

"But that’s when I’m of a lower rank than you."

"Are you saying your level is higher than mine now?"

Certainly, when I looked at me now, I was insignificant.

I do not have a solid embodiment like Yoo Joonghyuk, nor do I have powerful mental skills like Nirvana.

I do not lead a powerful group like Anna, nor do she have a sponsor that everyone knows about.

But there is one thing I am confident about.

[Story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is hungry.]

'Stories.'

"How can you—"

Anna's eyes widened as she sensed the story flowing from my body.

It has to be that way.

Because I have already collected three stories. And exactly in those three stories, there was a clear difference in class between me and the other incarnations.

"We don’t have time. What are you going to do?"

Anna Croft still seemed hesitant.

The fact that her 'blood' is an elixir is still a top secret. The moment this fact is revealed, incarnations from all over the world will target her.

So for her to display this ability in front of me now was already a gamble.

Anna, who was worried, eventually received the Dragon Heart.

"It will take about 5 minutes. You are confident, right?"

I stepped in front of her with my back to Anna.

"Of course."

Yoo Joonghyuk, trampling on Nirvana, was crying towards the sky.

[The attribute 'Cyclic Delay' is activated.]

I slowly took a breath and circulated the magical energy throughout my body.

—Youngest.

'Yes. Is it possible now?'

[Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint’s cooldown has already ended.]

[Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint 'Stage 3' is in effect!]

The problem was probability.

Even if Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint was at level 3, it was not completely free from the influence of probability.

—Is it possible?

But it's different now.

I knew it instinctively.

Like when Yamata no Orochi descended on [Peace Land], the 'probability aftermaths' do not blow in their normal form in this scenario.

In other words, this scenario works by putting each other's status on the 'scale' and canceling out each other's probabilities.

Then.

「This time, we may be able to use the true power of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.」

I activated [Incite] at the right time.

「I am Kim Dokja.」

['Incite' goes hand in hand with 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint'!]

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor is increasing!]

It feels like a layer of film is being placed on my soul, like wearing hard yet soft clothes.

As I slowly blinked, the scenery of the world changed. The high sky became even lower, and the gaze of the Constellations felt more blatant.

[Some Constellations are surprised by your status! ]

[The Constellations of the National Tree pay homage to your status .]

[The Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is surprised as to whether you actually have hidden powers.]

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' is looking closely at your story.]

[The constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' looks at you with his eyes wide open.]

Christina, who was standing a few steps away, stumbled.

As for her, if she really is an 'apostle', she will have no choice but to recognize who is possessing me now.

"As expected of you…"

Finally, Yoo Joonghyuk looked this way. The moment our eyes met, I knew the bastard would move.

"Come, Yoo Joonghyuk."

At the same time as control of the body was transferred to Kim Dokja, 'Unbreakable Faith' flashed in the air.

Yoo Joonghyuk's flying front foot and the brilliantly rising 'Blade of Faith' collided with each other.

Coo coo coo coo!

The blade and forepaw collided and a loud noise erupted.

I was taking the attack from that monstrous beast.

—Woah! Are you that surprised? Even if I look like this, I am 'fable grade'.

I realize it again.

That playful 'neighborhood brother' is actually a shining 'Constellation' in the sky.

—I cannot properly use even 10% of my power in this incarnation.

To be exact, even that '10%' was difficult.

The muscles of my entire body were screaming, and I could feel my magic power quickly depleting in real time.

—The decision will be made within 5 minutes.

The tale began to tell its story on Kim Dokja's behalf.

[The story 'King of a Kingless World' begins its storytelling !]

The first story obtained by Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

「No king under the heavens of this world can call himself true.」

The 'King of a Kingless World' was declaring to the 'Supreme King'.

「Only the king who denies the king will exist.」

The power of the story exploded and I kicked the ground and ran. I felt confident that I could cut down anything that got in my way.

'Blade of Faith' expanded explosively.

For the first time, a hint of confusion appeared in the eyes of that scary beast.

Sugagak.

The cut off black fur fluttered in the air and blood splattered. Yoo Joonghyuk's stance, which was focused on attack, was changing.

A cautious defensive stance centered on [Strong Self-Defense].

In that brief moment, the beast made a decision. This 'story' cannot be used for very long.

'Is it smart?'

Even Yoo Joonghyuk was instinctively suppressing the story of the 'Supreme King'.

As if he knew that the moment he used that story, 'King of Kingless World' would be used.

All he uses are 'beast' techniques that rely solely on instinct.

—I don’t know if Yoo Joonghyuk is smart or if the demon possessing him is smart.

The story of 'King of a Kingless World' was spreading in real time.

As he expected, my incarnation body could not maintain the power of a legendary story for long.

'What should I do now?'

—We have to use other means.

Other means?

The moment I was about to ask what else there was, a message rang in my head.

A sigh flowed from within.

This is the technology that made 'Kim Dokja' into a 'reader'.

He defeated numerous enemies with this technique and absorbed their power as his own.

[Exclusive skill 'Bookmark' is activated!]

In my head, I ran through a list of countless characters that Kim Dokja had read about so far.

Some characters I knew, some I didn't even know.

Some characters were too weak to be appropriate for use at the moment, while others were so strong that it was impossible to know if probability would allow it.

—There are people to choose from.

However, there was no hesitation in Kim Dokja's choice.

[Bookmark number 11 has been activated!]

—If this guy is the '41st Round', there is someone who must be chosen.

I felt like the magical energy in my whole body was shaking violently and I got goosebumps.

I realized who I had become.

「The pure white coat was covered with white fur.」

I never thought I would see this scenery with my own eyes.

[Bookmark number 11 'Disaster of Floods Shin Yoosung' is activated!]

[Exclusive skill 'Beast Lord’s Sensitivity Lv.???' is activated!]

White fur fluttering like white snow.

Yoo Joonghyuk's pupils wavered as he looked this way. Even someone with only instincts would have noticed.

No matter how strong the beast-turned-guy is, he can't defeat me now.

「"I am the 'Beast Lord'."」

Shin Yoosung, the Disaster of Floods.

「"King of all 'monsters'."」

Kim Dokja rushed over in an instant and hit Yoo Joonghyuk on the head with the side of the blade.

One shot, two shots, three shots.

Even though it seemed like an attack that could be easily avoided, Yoo Joonghyuk could not avoid it. Like a subject who cannot disobey the king's orders.

Every time Yoo Joonghyuk's head was hit, 41st Shin Yoosung's story was told.

「"What on earth were we to the Captain?"」

「"I hate you for living alone in this world."」

「"I will end your world in the most horrific way."」

No matter what anyone says, they cannot say that this pain is a lie.

41st round Shin Yoosung's very existence was the crime of 41st Round Yoo Joonghyuk.

As if receiving punishment for his crime, Kim Dokja delivered a powerful kick to Yoo Joonghyuk's stomach.

Yoo Joonghyuk flew about ten meters and fell, breaking the window of the National Assembly building.

「"Ahjussi… Can I call you that too?"」

The moment Kim Dokja heard that voice again, he stopped.

Whose memory is this?

Shin Yoosung, or Shin Yoosung in the 41st Round?

Or not,

'Are you okay?'

Is this a memory of Kim Dokja, who was the 'Demon King of Salvation'?

—What if I'm not okay?

For the first time, I felt a certain emotion in Kim Dokja's voice.

He spoke like a person who does not want to let go of those emotions.

'Isn't it okay to say that I miss her when I miss her?'

Why is he so cold? Was the Kim Dokja I knew really that kind of person?

No.

At least the 'Demon King of Salvation' I know is...

—Because that's not my 'role'.

Role?

—It's up to the other 'Kim Dokja' to feel sad when he sees people.

The moment I heard those words, all my questions suddenly seemed to make sense.

When he first saw Jung Heewon, Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, and Shin Yoosung.

The reason why the words Kim Dokja used to call them felt somehow distant and unfamiliar, could not be—

'Why is that?'

Any Kim Dokja has the right to be sad. It's nice to see someone you like and you can call them in a friendly way.

You can talk about your feelings.

But he didn't do that.

—Because I am 'The First, Kim Dokja'.

Kim Dokja was looking at Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk, the beast that rose up from inside the Capitol, ran screaming.

He said, "Kim Dokja likes 'Ways of Survival'."

If seen from afar, it would have looked like black and white monsters swinging their claws at each other.

「Kim Dokja is more cold-hearted than anyone else.」

At the moment when Yoo Joonghyuk's claws caught on the tip of the fur of the 'Beast Lord's sensitivity', 'Unbreakable Faith' radiated light.

「Kim Dokja, who hates losses and hates Constellations.」

Yoo Joonghyuk stumbled after being hit.

Kim Dokja pushed forward without giving him any time to rest.

「In order for all other 'Kim Dokjas' to exist, Kim Dokja had to survive before anyone else.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was on the defensive, activated his skill.

「Breaking the Sky Meteor Strike.」

The strongest skill that Yoo Joonghyuk can use now was revealed.

A bundle of force that tears the world apart poured towards me.

「Kim Dokja chose to become the Demon King to save someone.」

Kim Dokja was not embarrassed and slowly opened his arms. As if embracing a shattered world.

['Monster Gate' is activated.]

Dozens of portals swirled in the air, and Disaster-level monster species popped out at the same time.

The various breaths that poured out from the mouth of the monster species offset the bundle of strong energy of the broken meteor shower.

「He is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.」

As he slowly approached, a feeling of fear appeared in the black beast's pupils.

Kim Dokja smiled faintly, as if to appease Yoo Joonghyuk.

"I'll just take what's mine back."

The 'Kim Dokja fragment' that was stuck in Yoo Joonghyuk's back was pulled out along with blood.

And at that very moment, the forgotten memories of the 'Demon King of Salvation' returned.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 706 Episode 26 Star Ladder (2)

I looked at Kim Dokja in the window of a broken building.

He was standing there with Cheon Inho's face, but he was still a Kim Dokja.

The first Kim Dokja of this world.

He existed before any Kim Dokja.

He was courageous to live, so he decided to keep or not keep things.

He chooses and decides before all Kim Dokjas.

He is the most responsible.

「Kim Dokja's salvation is cruel.」

The Demon King of Salvation.

「The person who was saved by him is injured as if he saved a person who was drowned by the tip of the knife.」

He was resented for saving someone. He was reprimanded by the people he saved for hurting them.

「"I tell you not to be funny... What is this salvation..."」

But the people who were so saved knew.

「"Why are you...?"」

They saw Kim Dokja's hand when he was holding his sword.

「The reader has a lot of scars in his hand.」

When Kim Dokja saved someone with the tip of the knife, he also had a blade.

「"Don't worry. If I die once and survive, it will disappear."」

The wounds of the hand quickly disappeared, but people remembered the wound.

I checked his hand over and over again, and I was relieved to see his hand.

One day, Kim Dokja accepts that he will save them again with his hands.

'Constellation-nim.'

The Demon King of Salvation was looking down at his hand.

The hand was my hand, so there was no scar.

What memory had he regained?

Even though I used [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] I did not see his memory.

'Constellation-nim?'

Kim Dokja, who raised his head at my question, looked up at the sky.

His smile's meaning was unknown. It seemed broken, bitter, or seemed to understand everything.

"One more."

With that expression, Kim Dokja grabbed the head of a black beast. And with the other hand, he began to draw his own fragments on the back of the beast.

"One more."

Yoo Joonghyuk incarnation trembled as if he had seizures every time the fragments that were stuck on his back disappeared.

Oh oh oh oh!

With the painful roars that burst out of the beast's mouth, the people who heard it moaned.

"Ahhh…"

"What the hell—"

People were now watching the Demon King of Salvation, not the Black Beast.

People's expressions reflected in my eyes sharing his view.

Watching me, walking back, fearing me, and running away.

Kugu Gugu!

I once again called Kim Dokja.

'Constellation-nim!'

Kim Dokja didn’t answer. He just recovered the fragments from Yoo Joonghyuk’s back.

Three, four, five...

More than half of the fragments were now recovered.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was on his knees, looked up at me with half-empty pupils.

Suddenly I felt ominous.

「Only one Kim Dokja.」

Perhaps all Kim Dokjas dream of a single Kim Dokja.

Then that 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Wouldn't he want to be a single 'Kim Dokja', which was the first.

"Don't move."

Kim Dokja, who lifted the black beast's head with his left hand, bent his knees as if he was overpowering him. Subsequently, he continued to extract the fragments with his right hand.

Every time the fragments were pulled out, more and more memories were coming back.

His memories were his stories.

As the stories come back, the power of the Demon King of Salvation becomes stronger.

Tsutsutsutsu!

Now it was really dangerous.

The demon that was tired of Kim Dokja’s beating was completely silent.

But Kim Dokja did not leave him alone.

"Stop it and come out. If you don't want to die."

In a word, the soul of the demon that had been harassing us so far came out from Yoo Joonghyuk.

Oh oh oh oh!

The Demon, who lost his place to go, shed a story like a flame.

「I didn't have any bad intentions. I didn't have any bad intentions.」

He was incredibly shabby for a Marquis-level Demon.

「Please save me. Please save me.」

The Demon continued to talk as if he were Kim Dokja.

「I just. I just ...」

Kim Dokja said to such a Demon.

"You would have wanted to be the Demon King of Salvation."

The soul didn’t reply.

"Do you still want to be the 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

The soul trembled once again.

"Then come here."

As Kim Dokja opened his mouth, the Demon's soul was sucked into my mouth. It wasn't in me. I could senses it. The Demon's soul was absorbed into the story of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

When the Demon disappeared, Yoo Joonghyuk, who lost his consciousness, became limp.

'Kim Dokja.'

I finally called Kim Dokja. If he did not answer this time, I would forcibly release Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint. However.

—I'm listening.

Kim Dokja replied.

—I thought about the old days.

I was a little relieved because Kim Dokja was still the 'Demon King of Salvation' that I remember.

'Did you regain your memory?'

His appearance of ruthlessly extracting fragments was not forgotten.

What kind of memory did Kim Dokja see to lose his reason?

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' makes a dissatisfied look.]

Even the fragments were not absorbed by my stories.

In other words, it meant that the Demon King of Salvation had absorbed all eight 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.

—That…

The moment Kim Dokja tried to say something in a bitter voice.

Tsutsutsutsutchut!

Sparks began to drive in the air and lightning struck the ground.

Is there a probability aftermath?

It could not be. This scenario would be a safe zone in the aftermath.

Is the price of the Demon King of Salvation transcending the scenario’s standard?

My body was trembling in jeopardy. Even though I used [Omniscient Readers' Viewpoint], I could not afford the price of the Demon King of Salvation.

But that's... no, wait a minute.

Kurreung!

Once again, some incarnations were approaching this side.

The incarnations who have been watching the situation so far.

As soon as he confirmed the '4th grade Earth Dragon' equipment they had, Kim Dokja frowned at them.

Zarathustra?

"James. What are you trying to do now?"

Anna Croft blocked them. She was embarrassed by his actions as Zarathustra's sudden behavior was unexpected.

"I'm trying to run 'prophecy.' Why?"

"Prophecy? I have never told you of prophecy."

"I know. I'm tired of your prophecy now."

The man called James grumbled and looked back on other incarnations.

"I was used because I had no strength. I was trampled by the monster. All of us are tired."

"What do you want to say?"

"We have made a contract."

The woman at the back of James came forward and said.

"Anna Croft, like you."

Anna, who looked dazzled, muttered as she shook her head.

"No way ... what are you—"

[The Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' is astonished at the choice of the incarnation!]

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' is questioning his eyes!]

[The Constellation 'King Heungmu the Great' shouts that you are insane!]

However, even the dissatisfied Constellations could not dare to take a gesture beyond indirect message.

The Nebula, which exists behind the incarnations now, was a group of historical-grade Constellations.

[Nebula <Asgard> watches the scenario.]

The night sky of the highest star stream. One of their highest seats.

Only an indirect message rang, but there was a strong pressure.

Some incarnations had difficulty to breathe and knelt down to the ground.

Anna Croft, who lost her calm, shouted at Zarathustra’s members.

"Do you know what the hell you did? You are now—"

"Asgard's representative incarnation."

The woman laughed and talked.

"So far, the representative incarnation of 'Asgard' was one of you, but—"

James received her words.

"Now it's not."

At the same time, the light rose from ten Zarathustra’s members.

I realized what happened.

They chose to be the incarnations of Asgard.

[Incarnation James Johnson receives the will of the Nebula 'Asgard'.]

[Incarnation Olivia Harris receives the will of the Nebula 'Asgard'.]

[Incarnation Harper Davis receives the Will of the Nebula 'Asgard'.]

The dazzling light shone onto ten incarnations.

"<Asgard>! Save us!"

"We have kept our promise! Now liberate us from this terrible scenario!"

Anna urgently shouted at them.

"No! Stop!"

The incarnations of Zarathustra opened their arms towards the sky. Soon their bodies began to oxidize in the light.

The incarnations who realized that something was wrong too late struggled and shook their hands and feet, but the situation was already irreversible.

"Uh, why—"

"Aaaaaa!"

The skin of the incarnation was scattered with ash powder.

And.

[The Constellation 'Cleanser' descends!]

The stars began to descend into their bodies.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Married Three Times' descends!]

[The Constellation 'Valkyrie's Daughter' descends!]

…

The Constellations that entered the bodies of the incarnations opened their eyes one by one.

Half-body advent.

Again, it was only the seventh scenario. The great Constellations attempted a half-descent in the seventh scenario.

It was impossible.

Even if it was to match the 'balance of probability', which was destroyed by the Demon King of Salvation.

"No, run away!"

The incarnations who confirmed the situation began to run away without looking back.

It was natural.

The half-body advent of the Constellations was shocking enough to turn over the entire scenario.

So I was not worried.

[The Management Bureau is urgently involved in the region.]

The Management Bureau cannot intervene in this situation.

[The sub scenario’s probability is suspended.]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> moves.]

[The management country is in contact with Asgard.]

The situation could not be resolved in the yard by the Management Bureau.

But why is it?

The half-body advent of the Constellations was not solved.

[Nebula <Asgard> declares 'Gineunggap' all over the scenario area.]

Subsequently, a shocking system message was heard.

[Giant story 'Long Farmhouses' starts its storytelling.]

['Stage' occurs.]

The sky in the area swirled and all the lights of the sky turned off.

Long Farmhouses.

[NOTE 1]

The first empty space where the myth of Asgard began.

The first void where there was no scenario and no story.

If the Nebula allowed the stage, the meaning was obvious.

—They're going to hide what happens here now.

But why did they suddenly have such a great transfer?

No matter why the Nebula <Asgard> does this, it is a huge blow to the Giant Story of the Nebula.

Nevertheless, doing this meant that there was something to get even if they lose money.

Ten seats, including Valkyrie's daughter, were looking at us.

[We finally meet, 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

The moment I heard that, I thought I understood.

「Asgard knows about the Demon King of Salvation.」

If all this scenario was planned from the beginning.

「Why did the Demon appearing in Washington impersonate the 'Demon King of Salvation?」

Suddenly everything felt clear.

「If this scenario is a scenario created to attract the "Demon King of Salvation. '」

If the Dark Sentinel impersonating the Demon King of Salvation, Yoo Joonghyuk becoming a black beast, and all the rest was someone's plan.

If so, their goal was clear.

「The Nebula of this world are already gathering 'Kim Dokja's Fragments'.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Not sure about this name.I also knew that name.

# 707 Episode 26 Star Ladder (3)

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The 41st round was unlike any other round that had ever existed.

Because in this world, there was something called 'Kim Dokja Fragment'.

A piece that can evolve a Dark Sentinel into a higher monster species by collecting just one.

If you think about it, even Asmodeus, who evolved into an Outer God, was gathering 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.

In such a situation, there was no way that the Constellations of Giant Nebulas, who had better information than anyone else, would not know about Kim Dokja's Fragments.

[Is it you?]

The Constellations that descended before my eyes were proof of that.

'I should have expected it!'

The situation is such that apostles are scattered in various countries and the intensity of filtering has decreased. The Giant Nebulas should have made their moves while being aware of 'Kim Dokja'.

But the situation was already bad.

They dug a trap to catch the 'Demon King of Salvation' and we were caught in it.

'Constellation-nim.'

—It's okay.

Even in the face of crisis, Kim Dokja remained calm.

[You don't look as strong as I heard.]

[The level of the incarnation is also poor.]

[Is it really worth bringing in? I cannot understand the intentions of the Mythical Constellations.]

[Don’t look at it. Still, it is the first fragment of the 'Oldest Dream'.]

[Are you talking about the abolished god?]

Unlike the Constellations in the sky, the Constellations here talked carelessly.

This place is 'Ginnongagap'.

Is it because they know that no one records the story of this place and that no Constellation except them can see this place?

Kim Dokja asked the arrogant Constellations.

"Are you looking for me?"

Even in front of the ten Constellations lined up, Kim Dokja was confident. As if he were certain that they alone could not do anything about him.

The Constellations seemed both impressed and angry at Kim Dokja's attitude.

The Constellations, who were twinkling as if radiating all their emotions, finally gathered their opinions and closed their mouths.

The first to step forward was 'Valkyrie’s Daughter'.

The Constellation, wearing a winged helmet and plate armor decorated with alabaster metal, glared at Kim Dokja once, then smiled and spoke.

[To be exact, you came to visit us.]

"I don’t remember looking for you."

[We called you. I was curious whether the real 'Demon King of Salvation' would come.]

As expected, was this scenario a trap designed by <Asgard>?

"So what are your thoughts on seeing me?"

[Come to us, 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

Valkyrie's daughter smiled seductively and beckoned. Kim Dokja asked, tilting his head with a crooked expression.

"What do you mean?"

[It means that I will accept you as a Constellation of <Asgard>.]

It was an unexpected suggestion.

An invitation from <Asgard>.

This has happened often in the main story, and I also received an invitation from <Asgard> right after hunting down the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

But it was not in the same form as it is now.

[Nebula <Asgard> invites the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' to join the Nebula.]

[There is no penalty of any kind for this request.]

Join the Nebula with no conditions.

Have they ever offered such unconventional conditions?

When I was asked to join, <Asgard> put forward an 'absolute command' as a condition for the next 200 years.

[This is not everything. If you come to our Nebula, we will also support your incarnation.]

Was it because of an unexpected suggestion? Kim Dokja did not answer right away and remained silent for a moment. The 'Valkyrie's Daughter' probably thought the silence was a positive sign and continued speaking.

[I will give you a privilege that no other incarnation has received before. You will also be able to share our legendary stories and relics. Then your incarnation will be able to climb these scenarios faster than anyone else.]

Asgard's legendary stories and relics.

If their proposal is true, as soon as I accept the proposal, I will be treated better than 'Anna Croft'.

At that moment, I made eye contact with Anna Croft, who was looking at me from a few steps away. She was listening to this conversation with a confused look, as if she didn't know what was going on.

Kim Dokja briefly glanced at Anna and then asked again.

"If I just sign up, you'll do it all for me?"

[Yes]

"What kind of telecommunication company are you?"

[Telecommunication company? What does that mean?]

"Can you swear by the name of 'One-Eyed Matreya'? You really won't put any conditions on it?"

The Constellations just looked at each other without answering. Then, one of the Constellations belatedly took action.

[How dare you mention my father's name—]

"That doesn't seem possible."

Kim Dokja lightly sneered.

"I don't believe in unconditional favor. It's obvious that there will be strange clauses attached. You Nebula people have always been like that."

I also had the same thoughts as Kim Dokja.

In the first place, there is no reason for ten people to come here out of pure kindness.

Finally, one of the Constellations couldn't stand it anymore, frowned at him and stepped forward.

The one who had defended her father spoke up.

[I won’t talk too much. Return the 'fragments' you have collected to <Asgard> immediately.]

[One who washes cleanly. Step back!]

[Daughter of the Valkyrie, we have no time to waste. 'Gingagap' doesn't last very long.]

Kim Dokja shrugged his shoulders and laughed.

"Look at this. How good is it that we can be honest with each other?"

Ten Constellations looked this way at the same time.

[I will ask you one last question. Are you going to join our Nebula?]

"I’m sorry, but I’m already the representative of a certain Nebula."

The moment I heard those words, my heart started beating without me knowing.

This is because the 'Demon King of Salvation' who spoke those words was like Kim Dokja from the story I remembered.

Perhaps the memories Kim Dokja recovered from the past were about <Kim Dokja Company>.

The noisy Constellations frowned and said.

[Which Nebula did you join?]

"Kim Dokja's Company."

[Such a Nebula does not exist.]

As he said, there is no Nebula called <Kim Dokja Company> in this world line. Maybe there won't be any in the future.

Then Kim Dokja said:

"Yes. Low-level guys like you wouldn’t know about them."

[You...!]

As as many as ten Constellations stared at me, I felt an enormous sense of pressure.

Gazes that have saved and killed countless incarnations so far.

But Kim Dokja did not feel intimidated at all.

If I thought about it, he had endured this kind of gaze all along. After the scenario began, maybe even before it began.

[If you reject our offer, you will perish here. With your incarnation.]

"Can you do it with just you?"

Kim Dokja laughed darkly.

The monster that had grown by devouring the gaze of the stars was now glaring at them from the same spot as the stars.

Coo coo coo coo coo.

As an unusual current began to flow, the embarrassed Constellations also expressed their anger in earnest.

I paid attention to the black hand of the 'Cleaner' who was leading them.

'Constellation-nim, that black hand.'

Kim Dokja also seemed to remember that hand and nodded his head.

—That's right.

The hand that has retrieved the souls of readers whenever they have died.

A white scar remained on the back of the Constellation's hand.

It was a wound I cut with my 'Unbreakable Faith'.

Hell, these guys are one of the criminals who kidnap the souls of readers whenever they die.

"Rather, I should make a suggestion. Give me all the 'Kim Dokja Fragments' you have collected so far."

[What?]

"Then, I will help you prevent Ragnarok from happening in this world line."

[How dare you to <Asgard>—]

"You must speak clearly. You are not <Asgard>."

My body, possessed by Kim Dokja, slowly rose into the air.

「Way of the Wind.」

Hair and coats were blowing violently in the wind, accompanied by fierce wind pressure.

"At most, you are only ten 'historical-grade Constellations'."

[It seems like you don't really understand what kind of situation you're in.]

In response to Kim Dokja's provocation, the Constellations of <Asgard> continued to speak with a calmer tone.

[I already know about you. You were quite a famous Constellation in other world lines.]

[But whoever you are, your story will not work here.]

[Because this is a stage before the 'stories' have yet been written.]

In hindsight, I understood their leisure.

This is the stage of the beginning, 'Ginnongagap'. Kim Dokja's story does not show its true power here.

Nevertheless, Kim Dokja did not lose his composure.

"Okay?"

[Capture him.]

Ten Constellations flowed out at the same time and rushed towards Kim Dokja.

Kim Dokja looked at them and said.

"It looks like the Constellations above have heard about my story, but it looks like no one has told you exactly what it is."

The person who claimed to be the leader is 'The One Who Washes Cleanly'.

As soon as he held out his hand, wearing pitch-black gloves, dozens of shadow hands came rushing in.

"They don’t know either."

Beast Lord's Sensitivity protected me from the flying shadow hand, and at the same time, the disaster species released their breath from the Monster Gate that opened. It was the same tactic that had previously subdued the 'Black Beast'.

Coo coo coo coo!

But this time, the opponent is a 'Constellation'.

From an incarnation’s point of view, Shin Yoosung's monsters are strong, but from the stars' point of view, it is different.

[Just like a monster!]

A Constellation dressed as a Viking sent his ax flying towards the gate. The ax, loaded with fierce fighting power, created a gust of wind, blowing off the heads of the monsters and even tearing off the entrance to the gate.

Some of the frightened disaster species stuck out their necks and ran away in panic.

[Give up your head!]

After all, a Constellation is a Constellation.

This was an enemy on a different level from the enemies I had fought so far.

So why am I not that nervous?

Is it because Kim Dokja is with me?

—Did you forget that we killed the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'?

Memories of confronting the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' at the end of the fourth scenario.

It was like that.

Come to think of it, I have already faced enemies stronger than them.

—You said that back then.

I still remember the events of that day vividly. The day I gained the Demon King of Salvation as a sponsor and came back from the dead.

The day Han Sooyoung disappeared.

—You are Kim Dokja.

That day, I swore to Han Sooyoung.

I accepted who I was.

'I think it should be so.'

But if I accept that, does that mean I become 'Kim Dokja'?

—It’s still not enough.

I was angry, but I had no choice but to admit it.

If he, and no one else, said so, it would be so.

'I know.'

I have an excuse.

Even if I am a part of Kim Dokja, I have not lived 'Kim Dokja’s life'.

I've written and read stories about him, but I really don't know what he was like.

I don't know him as a person. I do not know how he laughed, what tone of voice he spoke, or what thoughts he lived through the many lines that are not described.

In a way, I'm finally starting to understand it little by little.

—Youngest.

I am learning about Kim Dokja.

—I hope you survive.

It's still difficult.

—Remember. How does 'Kim Dokja' fight? See it clearly with your own two eyes and write it down.

Sometimes it's lonely, lonely, and difficult, so it's hard for me to do it alone.

[The synchronization rate with your sponsor is increasing!]

At that moment, a scene unfolded in my mind.

It was a library.

As we moved on, Kim Dokja was standing beyond the swaying candela lights.

Kim Dokja quickly passed by the bookshelves, then stopped and took out a book from one of the shelves.

There were traces of Kim Dokja reading and rereading the pages he opened.

When I turned my head, Kim Dokja was looking at me.

—From now on, we will read together.

I nodded.

[The exclusive skill 'Bookmark' is activated!]

Ten Constellations attacked us at the same time.

A blade that shines pure white. Frozen Changgeuk. Arrows blazing with flames and shadowy hands piercing like awls.

I couldn't take on any of them on my own.

But it's different when we're together.

[Bookmark 5 has been activated!]

[Your current body composition is different from that of the character.]

[Your 'strength' overcomes the physical condition penalty.]

I felt goosebumps deep inside my mind and an indescribable sense of liberation.

「He is truly Kyrgios's disciple.」

It's different from the time when all I could do was just barely imitate with [Incite].

「The paradoxical White Blue, the successor to the vision of 'Kyrgios Rodgraim'.」

The magical power of white and blue, burning like a wildflower, dyed us blue.

[Exclusive skill 'Electrification Lv.???' has been activated.]

Kim Dokja, who became a blue holy light, passed by the first line of Constellations.

The Constellation 'the Cleanser' who was standing in the first line, looked back at us with astonished eyes.

"If you really wanted to catch me."

Kim Dokja said without even looking at him.

"You should have brought at least a Mythical-grade Constellation."

The three Constellations in the first row were split in half.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 708 Episode 26 Star Ladder (4)

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One day after 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' was completed, there was a time when Ji Eunyu was collecting comment questions for a questionnaire survey.

Among them, one question was noticeably overlapping.

"How strong is Kim Dokja?"

World, I was curious too.

How strong is Kim Dokja?

When I actually tried to write the answer, I couldn't figure out how strong Kim Dokja was.

This is because the standard of strength in 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is 'stories'.

Kim Dokja accumulated stories through indiscriminate efforts, and the more stories he accumulated, the stronger he became.

In Part 1, five stories were collected to become the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

In Part 2, he obtained his first 'Giant Story' by defeating 'Surya', The Supreme God of Light, a Mythical-grade Constellation.

In Part 3, he got the second big story after the 1,863rd round and ‘Gigantomachia’.

In Part 4, he became the youngest member of 'The Great Sage Heaven Equal', which became complete after the Holy Demon Battle, and completed the rest of the 'Giant Story'.

Kim Dokja, who finally reached Part 5, became this world itself.

What does it mean to become a world?

Is it possible to measure the 'strength' of the being that has become the world?

Even now, I don’t know the answer.

However, I have something to say about 'Kim Dokja before he became the world'.

For example, Kim Dokja in 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint Part 1'.

Kim Dokja became a Narrative level Constellation and earned the title 'Demon King of Salvation'.

If someone asks, this is how I would describe his strength.

「"Well, wouldn’t it be possible to wipe out about ten historical-grade people?"」

And unfortunately, the Constellation in front of me did not hear my answer.

[I’ve never heard of a story like this—]

The incarnation of the 'Cleaner' who was muttering in disbelief slowly separated into upper and lower parts.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Washes Clean' has suffered a terrible blow to his true body!]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Washes Clean' leaves the scenario!]

The incarnation body, freed from half-body descent, crumbled into white bones, and the exit messages of the other two Constellations that had suffered the same thing rang out one after another.

[The Constellation 'Survivor of a Secret Country' exits the scenario!]

[The Constellation 'The Wise Young Man' leaves the scenario!]

A tragedy that occurred in an instant.

The Constellations were speechless.

The power of the Constellation cannot be used in the form of Half-God Advent.

But even so, Constellations are Constellations, beings that are recognized as such by gathering as many as five stories.

These were never great people who would suffer in vain like this.

[Valkyrie's daughter. How did that happen?]

[How on earth did that guy—]

[Everyone, don’t panic. That level is far below his original status.]

[A lot lower? Just how strong was that Constellation—]

'Valkyrie’s Daughter' answered with a cold expression.

[The final classification grade of the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' was 'Myth Grade'.]

A Mythical Constellation.

At those words, the seven Constellations opened their mouths at each other at the same time.

[Mythical level? Aren’t you misunderstanding something?]

[Why didn’t you inform me of that fact sooner!]

Kim Dokja said, as if he was enjoying the commotion.

"You seem to know something. Those poor historical-grade seem to have come without knowing anything."

The Constellations now looked as if they were about to scream.

But in fact, Kim Dokja was not in a situation to relax that much. I knew more than anyone else because I was the one who lent him my body.

Crumble.

Even though I was not receiving any probability aftermath, my body was already tearing in various places.

An incarnation that was destroyed by just one 'Constellation'.

This is the 'class' of a Mythical-level Constellation.

'Constellation-nim.'

—I know.

Now, there is a limit to the number of [Full-Personalization] that can be done with this body.

On the other hand, there are seven remaining historical-grade Constellations.

Nevertheless, Kim Dokja did not lose his composure .

"If you die here, no record will be left behind. Are you all ready to disappear cleanly?"

I thought it would be better if they got scared and ran away like this, but there was no way the situation would be resolved that easily.

'Valkyrie’s Daughter' stepped forward and spoke.

[Constellations of the great <Asgard>. There's no need to be scared. 'Mythical grade' is just a story from another world line. Now he is just a fragment of a discarded god.]

A discarded god. They used that expression before too.

[His true body has already been cruelly torn apart by the great 'Mythical Constellations'. He cannot use the power he had in his prime. Just like the monkey star in <The Emperor>.]

I was a little embarrassed.

What is that punk talking about now?

Kim Dokja's 'true body' is torn?

And the one who did that was a Mythical Constellation?

Is it possible?

I didn't understand.

Based on the completion of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Kim Dokja has a status that goes beyond a Mythical Constellation and can be called the absolute ruler of this world.

Did Kim Dokja suffer like that?

Are other Mythical Constellations that strong?

I thought of the Mythical Constellations representing each Nebula.

For example, the Constellations of the 'last scenario' such as Odin, the 'One-Eyed Matreya' in <Asgard>, or the 'Seat of Lightning' in <Olympus>.

Kim Dokja in the main story also chose to avoid them rather than confront them head on, so their strength was clearly proven.

But that was all before Kim Dokja became the 'Oldest Dream'.

Will Odin or Zeus be strong enough to deal with Kim Dokja after seeing the end of the scenario?

[Arrogant fragment of god. You are no longer the only observer in this world.]

What is clear is that 'Valkyrie's daughter' in front of us knows who the 'Demon King of Salvation' is.

[I'm sure you're still under the illusion that you can see and shape this world at will.]

And that he knows something about the secrets of this world.

'Constellation-nim, what does that mean? What does it mean that your body was torn?'

I wondered what would happen if he avoided answering, but Kim Dokja answered obediently.

—Literally. You already know. There is not just one 'Kim Dokja' in this world.

'Then what about the 'Oldest Dream'?'

According to what they said, there was a high probability that the 'Oldest Dream' did not exist in this world today.

When I thought about it that way, there were some things that immediately made sense.

「"You can only press the reset button once. In the next round, everything in this universe will be destroyed forever."」

In a flashback seen through Anna Croft, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 40th round said: the 41st round is his last life.

If Yoo Joonghyuk found out that there was a problem with his sponsor, and that caused a problem with his [Regression], then it was understandable that he said that.

However, if the 'Oldest Dream' had truly disappeared, the real problem was different.

'Who on earth is observing this world right now?'

The entire universe exists through Kim Dokja's observations, which became the 'Oldest Dream'.

But if the 'Oldest Dream' is absent, who will watch over this world on his behalf?

—Youngest, you probably have a lot of questions right now.

Just as Kim Dokja was about to reply to my words, the Constellations that gained courage once again surrounded us.

Kim Dokja opened his mouth with a bitter smile.

"Do you want to keep fighting? Even if I can’t show the strength I had in my prime, it’s easy to rip you to death."

[Maybe so. That is, if your incarnation body was fine.]

'Valkyrie's Daughter', who had suddenly changed her speaking style to an honorific one, smiled subtly and her bright eyes shone.

Stigmata "Sharp Eyes".

Although it is impossible to find out detailed information about the other person like with [Character List] or [Sage's Eyes], it is a technique to analyze the other person's current state through close observation of the other person's breathing, movement, tone of voice, or facial expression.

[Even if you have that much power, your incarnation body is already limited. Do you think I don’t know?]

Indeed, weren’t there not only stupid Constellations in <Asgard>?

After doing a complete analysis of our situation, Valkyrie's daughter gave orders to the other Constellations.

[Please gather your strength. I will deal with him directly.]

'Valkyrie’s Daughter' stood at the front representing the remaining Constellations.

Eventually, the Constellations continued, and the status of the seven Constellations was concentrated on a single Constellation.

The aura of 'Valkyrie's Daughter’, which had been fluttering red and blue, soon began to burn fiercely with pure white light.

「This place is now a yawning abyss.」

The spear she held in her hand burned fiercely, and a string of story stirred.

「The worlds of ice and fire were divided across the primordial void.」

The moment I read that line, I was depressed. Although it was a short sentence and not a full sentence, there was no mistake.

'Isn't that the Crest of Creation?'

I never thought it would come this far in <Asgard>.

The fact that they gave the Creation Crest to a Constellation that was only historical-grade means that they are that serious about this situation.

—I got caught by crazy people.

Kim Dokja also seemed troubled this time.

In any case, from a Nebula’s point of view, historical-grade Constellations are expendable. If only they could capture Kim Dokja by handing over the Creation Crest to them, it was a reasonable enough expense for <Asgard>.

[Well, try using that technique one more time.]

Now, that skill can only be used once.

My body has reached its limit, and now 'Valkyrie’s Daughter' risks her life.

If I defeat her, the remaining six Constellations will unite against us at the same time.

If that happens, it's over.

—Don’t worry, Youngest.

However, even in the face of an imminent situation, Kim Dokja remained calm.

Kim Dokja took a deep breath and shouted in an even louder voice.

"I don’t understand what you’re saying. You guys can’t do it. Why don’t you just call stronger Constellations?"

[We are enough for you—]

"Even if you say that the Mythical-grade Constellations are lazy, what are all the Mythical-grade Constellations doing? Don’t you guys have any of the 12 Olympus-grade Constellations? Is this the only Asgardian foot?"

Of course, there is a grade of '12 Olympus' in <Asgard>.

"Guardian of the Great Horn Bridge! Flame of Muspelheim! God of Harp and Horon! Where are you all hiding?"

As the Narrative-grade Constellations' descriptions flowed from Kim Dokja's mouth, the Constellations, including 'Valkyrie's Daughter', were startled.

Kim Dokja continued as if enjoying their reactions.

"Heimdall! Surtur! Tyr! Baldur! Where are you all hiding so you can’t see me? I’m here! Come get me!"

The Constellations, who belatedly noticed the situation, shouted in anxious voices.

[How dare you—]

I was equally anxious.

They say we're crazy, so we act like we’re crazy too.

So what are we going to do?

If a really angry Heimdall or Surtur shows up...

Then suddenly a strange thought crossed my mind.

Those bastards, really, why didn’t anyone come?

<Asgard> paid a great deal of probability for this event, to the extent of bringing 'Ginnungagap' to the stage. Why didn't they bring in the crucial Constellations when they were even given the Crest of Creation?

To put it bluntly, if a Constellation like Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father', a Mythical Constellation, or Thor, the 'Thunder of Thursday', had come from the beginning, we would have been reduced to ashes on the spot.

The fact that they couldn't do that....

"Coward Odin! If you want to catch me, come and see for yourself!"

As soon as Odin's name came out of Kim Dokja's mouth, the Constellations of Asgard turned pale.

[No—!]

Normally, lightning should have fallen from the sky by now.

The world was dead quiet.

Kim Dokja looked up at the sky for a moment and spoke as if laughing at the silence.

"It must be scary. The scale is tipping."

As soon as he said those words, the sky tore apart and a ray of lightning struck.

Grumble!

It was lightning from <Asgard>.

The high-ranking Constellations of <Asgard>, who had been silent throughout, eventually responded to Kim Dokja's provocation.

But at that very moment, the sound of something being torn apart was heard from across the sky struck by lightning. A terrible roar sounded as if the stars were being erased, and

the sky became quiet again.

The historical-grade Constellations looked up at the scene with wide eyes.

[W-what on earth—]

It was clear what had happened. One of the Constellations of <Asgard> beyond 'Ginnongagap' caused an uproar, and almost at the same time, someone struck a fatal blow to that Constellation.

But who on earth could do such a thing?

Who can bring down a Constellation of <Asgard>, which no Constellation in this universe can touch?

"If the scales tip, someone you can’t handle may come to you."

Kim Dokja looked up at the sky with a distant gaze. I looked up at the sky with him.

The moment the pitch-black sky of Ginnungagap rippled like a black coat, I also realized something.

I don't know who the 'Oldest Dream' that observes this world is.

However, I knew one person who was looking for Kim Dokja more than anyone else.

He is a being who is not afraid to face Nebulae.

The one who killed the most 'stars' in all of the universe and saw the end of the scenarios with Kim Dokja.

The protagonist of 'Ways of Survival',

「Beyond that curtain is the 'Yoo Joonghyuk' I knew.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 709 Episode 26 Star Ladder (5)

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As the chatter of <Asgard> subsided, the sky over Ginnungagap was covered in silence again.

A sky where no star dares to shine.

It was not simply because the veil of 'Ginnungagap' hid the starlight. Beyond that veil, there was a being that caught the light of all the stars.

Kim Dokja burst into laughter under his breath.

"Look, you can’t do that."

The historical-grade Constellation remained silent, unable to respond to those words.

They probably felt it too.

Just now, a Constellation from <Asgard> fell from beyond the sky of 'Ginnungagap'. I don't know what the Constellation's modifier or true name is. However, judging from the reactions of the historical-grade Constellation, it seems that he is not a weak guy.

That Constellation fell all at once.

'Is Yoo Joonghyuk over there?'

Kim Dokja looked up at the sky without answering.

What Kim Dokja can see, I can also see. However, Yoo Joonghyuk was not visible in Kim Dokja's eyes. All that was reflected in my eyes was a landscape that looked like a pitch-black blackout curtain.

—There is.

Still, we could imagine.

The fragments recovered by Kim Dokja were talking to us.

「"Kim Dokja. Are you there?"」

It was a voice from the distant past.

Words that his colleagues once searched for him with.

「"Dokja-ssi."」

「"Ahjussi! Can you hear me? Ahjussi!"」

Since this world line did not allow communication with them, their voices were nothing more than auditory hallucinations created by Kim Dokja's memories.

Still, we knew. Even if the voice is different, even if the pitch and content of the words are different, <Kim Dokja Company> is looking for Kim Dokja beyond the stage.

Because this is 'that kind of story'.

—In the end, all that remains is the story.

This story is all about Kim Dokja.

'Do you miss them?'

The agitation felt like a faint ripple and then subsided.

—I told you. That's not my responsibility.

Suddenly my emotions soared.

I wanted to tell the Demon King of Salvation.

You don't have to be that kind of person. There is no reason why you have to be the only 'Kim Dokja' like that.

But on the other hand, I understood what he was saying.

His story was telling.

「This is the way of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.」

He can only say that. From the time he was born, he had no choice but to live like that.

Just like that stubborn Yoo Joonghyuk.

At that moment, this thought occurred to me.

If every 'Kim Dokja' had his own role. If you live a story appropriate for that role.

So what is my role as 'Kim Dokja'?

['Ginnungagap' will be lifted soon.]

The pitch-black sky was shaking.

The first thing that came to me was relief that I had survived.

When this 'stage' is lifted, the Constellations will no longer be able to harm us.

Even if it was a scenario where the scale of probability was at play, even if the opponent was <Asgard>, one of the three powers of the 'Nebula', there was no way they could have suffered a bigger loss than this.

However, the historical-grade Constellation showed no sign of giving up yet.

[Don’t bluff. No great being can cross that veil now.]

Valkyrie's daughter was right.

In order for the Yoo Joonghyuk I know to descend here, at least a Mythical Constellation would have to appear and balance the scales.

But there is no way that 'Odin' would appear here just to catch us.

"That means the Constellations can’t come to help you."

[There is no need for help from other Constellations. Because we alone are enough to hunt you down.]

"The three of them were torn apart earlier."

At those words, a bright roar flowed from 'Valkyrie's Daughter', who inherited the status of the seven historical-grade Constellation.

[I know what the 'old you' looked like.]

The old Kim Dokja?

[I have seen it several times in the stories of the Mythical Constellations that hunted you. It was so fascinating that I couldn't help but watch it over and over again. In that story, you were truly beautiful.]

I was wondering.

Is Kim Dokja's true identity really as they claim?

Even if it remains as a 'story', there is no guarantee that the incident was true.

In some stories, the facts are contaminated by false propaganda.

'Valkyrie's Daughter' continued speaking in a cold voice.

[You are imitating God well despite the skin that God has shed.]

Those words struck my heart in a strange way.

"Imitate."

The Demon King of Salvation laughed without denying those words in any way.

The air around us began to vibrate. Seven Constellations, led by 'Valkyrie's Daughter', were approaching with all their might.

'Ginnungagap' is not over yet.

'What are you going to do?'

Three Constellations have already left. The remaining historical-grade Constellation will now risk their life to attack.

'If I use that skill one more time—'

—Then you'll die.

I know. But there is no other way.

—There is a way.

'Valkyrie's Daughter' flew into the air and threw out a spear, spewing out chills. A fierce gust of wind struck my waist as if the space around me was being compressed.

It's enormous.

Even if it is not a Mythical-grade attack, if it is an attack of this level, one hit will kill me instantly.

Even in that situation, Kim Dokja was still smirking.

"Seven of you attack someone with nothing but fault? If we do this, we'll have no choice but to call our side."

[There is no one on your side here—]

Kim Dokja put his hand into his chest and threw something toward the front.

Acrid smoke spread out with a small explosion sound.

'Poison Bomb.'

It was a trophy obtained when dealing with the Misreading association guys in the Star Labyrinth.

Naturally, it was an item that would not cause any harm to the Constellations.

[With just this insignificant skill!]

"Insignificant skill?"

The Constellations, startled by Kim Dokja's words, stopped for a moment.

Then, instead of running straight this way, they started creating wind pressure to blow away the smoke from the poisonous bomb.

They suspected that Kim Dokja might have set a trap.

But that was exactly the effect Kim Dokja was aiming for.

"Anna Croft."

Anna Croft, who was standing in the back, trembled at Kim Dokja's call.

Kim Dokja said, reaching out his hand toward her.

"Heart."

The processing of the 'Lesser Dragon’s Heart' that I requested earlier has just been completed.

Valkyrie's daughter, who witnessed the scene, warned.

[Prophet! What are you trying to do now!]

Anna Croft's movements stopped at the bloody voice.

[I'm sure you're not trying to betray <Asgard>.]

At those words, both Anna Croft, Selena Kim, and Christina Page who were by her side turned pale.

[Have you forgotten whose incarnation you are?]

The reason 'Zarathustra' was able to become as strong as it is now is because of the support of the Nebula <Asgard>.

Helping me in a situation where I and <Asgard> were at a loss was tantamount to betraying the Nebula behind her.

Anna Croft's 'Eye of the Great Evil' was seen turning red for a moment.

Tsutsutsu.

Anna Croft stumbled, frowning as sparks flew through the air.

She attempted to read the future with [Future Sight]. Judging by the expression on his face, [Future Sight] probably failed.

Anna Croft, who looked at us for a moment, lowered her head and said.

"I am definitely the incarnation of <Asgard>."

I understood.

In the seventh scenario, it was obvious what the price would be for betraying the third-tier Giant Nebula.

If she helps us now, Anna's group will be defeated. So her judgment now was extremely reasonable.

"But."

Anna Croft slowly raised her head, looked at 'Valkyrie's Daughter' and continued her words.

"I’m not sure if you can represent <Asgard>."

The moment I looked into Anna Croft's eyes, I slowly got goosebumps.

I forgot for a moment.

That she is a 'Gambler in Las Vegas'.

[What are you saying now?]

"This stage is from the beginning, 'Ginnungagap', what happened here is not recorded. Since it is not handed down, no one outside can know what happened here."

Anna Croft has just placed a bet.

"If you all die here, who will remember what I did?"

[What nonsense are you talking about? Prophet!]

A gamble with little chance.

A situation in which a normal 'Anna Croft' would never have intervened.

And yet now, Anna Croft has placed her entire stake on the conman she hates the most.

"Cheon Inho. Can you do it?"

I don’t know if Cheon Inho can do it or not. However, it was not Cheon Inho who was answering now.

"It is possible."

The Constellations realized something was wrong and shouted.

[Attack!]

In the meantime, we received the 'Refined Lesser Dragon Heart' from Anna Croft.

I wanted to ask her.

Why did you decide to help us?

In a situation where there is no future in sight, what on earth did you believe and bet on us?

"In no round was I recognized as a 'companion' by the Supreme King."

Anna Croft's gaze was focused on the fallen Yoo Joonghyuk.

"If such a powerful king recognized you as a comrade, there must be a good reason."

Anna Croft had a feeling that this round was the end of the world lines. Therefore, she may also have taken her last gamble.

"Joonghyuk has an eye for people."

The Constellations that cleared away the poisonous fog each fired their weapons.

The one that flew first was again the spear fired by 'Valkyrie's Daughter'.

The thunderous strike contained in the weapon flew over, turning the entire floor over.

[Kill! Recover the fragments!]

Kim Dokja dodged the spear and immediately swallowed the 'Lesser Dragon's Heart'.

[Use 'Refined Lesser Dragon's Heart'.]

My heart was beating loudly and my body was shaking violently. The magical power emanating from the dragon's heart was merging with my heart. Like the fable of a chrysalis becoming a butterfly, I felt my body breaking through its limits.

[Your body evolves!]

[The story of the 'Braqui Clan' dwells in your heart.]

But the opponents were Constellations.

It was not possible to overcome the defense just by absorbing a single 'Lesser Dragon's Heart' and increasing the amount of magical power.

The weapon that had passed us was flying back to us across the distant sky.

Considering that the range of the lightning discharged was larger than before, it seemed difficult to avoid it by fluke.

This time we have to hit with all our might.

—Youngest.

'Yes.'

The moment my heart beat loudly, the dragon's heart carried rough magical energy throughout my body.

As I felt pain due to torn blood vessels, pages started turning in my head.

[The exclusive skill 'Bookmark' is activated!]

We are Kim Dokja.

Readers fight in their own way.

—The person we need right now.

'It's a monster that can take on seven historical-grade Constellations.'

—It’s hard to do just that. The physical size doesn't match, so the cost of class is too high.

'It won't work even with a broken sword.'

A character who can defeat seven historical-grade Constellation.

There were many people that came to mind, but it was hard to think of anyone who could take them down without unduly harming the balance of the scales.

—There is one.

But will it work? That person is a 'Constellation'.

Originally, [Bookmark] only works on 'characters'.

In fact, in the Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Kim Dokja never once borrowed the power of 'Constellations' as a bookmark.

—Maybe, because I happened to get the 'Dragon Heart' too.

But it wasn't impossible.

There was definitely an increase in understanding of bookmarks for 'Constellations'.

'Then let's do it.'

An existence that is at the limit that my current body can handle and that the probability of the scale allows.

「"This guy was born to be a businessman."」

As the pages stopped turning, his history filled my ears.

「"I was born with the blood of a dragon."」

In the main story, there was no opportunity to borrow his power as a 'bookmark'.

This is because there was insufficient understanding.

[You possess the 'Dragon Heart'.]

[Your body specifications are similar to the person's body specifications.]

But what about now?

[Bookmark number 21 is activated.]

My heart was pounding loudly and my vision was distorted.

The rushing Constellations shouted as if they were struggling.

[I don't know what you're trying to do—]

[Kill him! At best, he can only use the power of a historical-grade Constellation!]

At best, he is a historical-grade Constellation.

However, even historical-grade Constellation have a hierarchy.

[Exclusive skill 'Three Swords Lv. ???' is activated!]

He is the most powerful Constellation.

He is a being who has never swung his sword at the same opponent more than three times in his life.

A warrior who cut down a thousand people with one sword, collapsed a mountain with two swords, and split the sea with three swords.

[Bookmark number 21 'Goryeo First Sword Cheok Jungyeong' is activated!]

The Constellation at the rear, who belatedly realized something, shouted.

[Wait, stop! Valkyrie's daughter! Something is wrong! Now he is—]

Before he could even finish his words, the entire landscape in front of him was torn apart.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 710 Episode 26 Star Ladder (6)

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Cheok Jungyeong's first Japanese meal that serves a thousand people at once.

One Sword That Splits The Sky.

I was familiar with its grandeur and performance. Because I wrote that sentence with my own hands.

When was it? Was it when Kim Dokja, who was imprisoned in [Hundred Days of Seal], borrowed 'Ganpyeongui' and summoned Cheok Jungyeong?

「A swordsmanship cultivated over a lifetime by a great genius who may only appear once every tens of thousands of years. The most ideal cut created solely for destruction.」

But now that I look at it, I feel like I need to change that sentence a bit.

Why didn't I write down that it hurts to use it?

No. Did I write it down? If it was written, it was insufficient.

It felt like someone had bent all my joints in a way that made them impossible to move. Even though [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] was activated, the pain was felt right down to my soul.

Looking at my tattered right hand, I wondered how on earth Kim Dokja could endure something like this.

—This is barely a sword, Youngest.

It's barely like this.

So, just what level of destructive power are Cheok Jungyeong's three swords and the four swords created after that?

—That Cheok Jungyeong was also blocked at 'historical-grade'. The guys you have to deal with in the future are higher than that.

I can't even guess.

What kind of story must we build to reach that place? Is it really possible to reach it?

How was it possible for Kim Dokja not to be scared even when facing that high sky?

—You can do it. Because we already did it once.

The thick dust cleared and there was only one Constellation left where the blade passed.

[How...]

The six brilliantly shining stars of <Asgard> have set.

There is only one thing left. Only 'Valkyrie's Daughter' remained. Even then, more than half of her incarnation body was blown away.

As her spear, which had been resting on the floor, scattered into powder, Valkyrie's Daughter fell to the ground.

[This technique is definitely that monster's...]

The trembling woman also seemed to recognize Cheok Jungyeong's sword.

Cheok Jungyeong, like Kim Dokja, was cursed with [Fate] and became an enemy of the Giant Nebula, so it was no surprise that Valkyrie's Daughter recognized this technique.

Afterwards, Valkyrie's Daughter, whose magic power flowed back, began to vomit.

[Oh, no. It can't end like this—]

And.

['Ginnungagap' ends.]

I felt the curtain surrounding me disappear. The curtain of 'Ginnungagap' staged in <Asgard> is finally about to disappear.

[The effect of 'Ginnungagap' is activated.]

[What happened in 'Ginnungagap' is not recorded in the world line.]

The curtain disappeared, revealing the ruined city of Washington. The incarnations nearby looked at each other blankly.

Valkyrie's Daughter, who had not yet been lifted from 'half-body advent', also looked embarrassed.

[How on earth did this happen...]

The reason that 'half-body advent' was not lifted is probably because the power of 'Valkyrie's Daughter' was damaged.

What was puzzling was her reaction.

[Wh-where has everyone gone! Constellations, what's going on! Why me—]

Valkyrie's daughter, who had been spouting off a bunch of stories, croaked. It seems as if she had forgotten all previous events.

She wasn't the only one having this strange reaction.

"Cheon Inho?"

Anna Croft, who had been watching the battle by my side, was asking with a confused look on her face.

"What on earth happened? Why is Valkyrie's daughter…? No, these traces…"

With those words, Anna activated [Past Sight]. But all that came back was a light spark.

Afterwards, it was felt that the incarnations of the area were shaking in confusion.

"What happened to the Black Beast?"

"What? Why am I here…"

"The Black Beast has fallen!"

"It’s a Constellation! A Constellation has descended!"

"I feel like my head is going to explode."

What happened inside 'Ginnungagap' is not recorded. However, this 'record' apparently also included the 'memories' of humans and Constellations.

Anna Croft, who had been staring blankly into space, came to her senses and muttered.

"No way... 'Ginnungagap'?"

She was also a prophet. Did she realize what had happened in that short period of time?

Anyway, it was disappointing.

The fact that everything that happened in 'Ginnungagap' was not recorded also meant that the things that happened there could not be made into stories.

It was unfair that the incident of executing as many as ten 'historical-grade Constellations' was not recognized as a story, but somehow they survived.

But when I thought about it, something felt strange.

「I remember all the incidents that happened in 'Ginnungagap'.」

Along with the feeling of my heart becoming cold, I felt the power of the story surrounding Kim Dokja and me.

[The story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear' is in effect.]

[You are not affected by the record erasure effect of 'Ginnungagap'.]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are greatly embarrassed.]

[The Nebula <Asgard> protests to the Bureau.]

.

.

[Your record will be sent to the <Star Stream>.]

[Your achievements have been recorded in the <Star Stream>.]

[You have achieved an achievement that does not exist!]

[The <Star Stream> reviews your achievements.]

Since when did it start? 'Valkyrie's Daughter's' expression was grotesquely distorted as she looked at me.

[Nonsense—How to do 'Ginnungagap'?]

She also realized what was happening.

She urgently looked up at the sky and burst out with her loud mantra.

[Stop it! Constellations! We must kill him quickly! Right now!]

Sparks of probability were swirling around 'Valkyrie's Daughter'.

[He remembers everything that happened inside 'Ginnungagap'!]

What it meant was clear.

I don't know why, but the incident we committed was recorded as a 'story'.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' requests to view the records.]

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' requests to view the records.]

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' requests access to the records.]

[The Constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' requests to view the records.]

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' requests to view the records.]

…

Endless indirect messages.

[The Management Bureau is reviewing your 'new story'!]

I said, suppressing my overflowing heart.

'Constellation-nim.'

If this incident is recognized as a 'story', I will get a story about the massacre of 'ten historical-grade Constellations' in the seventh scenario.

An impossible story told on a stage where recording is impossible.

An achievement that not even Kim Dokja in the main story could achieve.

I couldn't even guess what kind of story I was going to receive.

However, Kim Dokja—that is, the 'Demon King of Salvation'—looked strangely reluctant.

—This is not good.

'It's not good?'

—Youngest, do you remember that I was given [Fate]?

Of course I remember.

Because of the [Fate] he received at that time, Kim Dokja died several times and was even expelled from the scenario in the tenth scenario.

—That was the 'eight scenario'. But if this happens in only the seventh scenario, what do you think the Giant Nebulae will look like?

'Ah...'

—Shit. I thought it would be okay because it was 'Ginnungagap'.

I remembered what the 'Giant Nebulae' were.

In this <Star Stream>, these guys are more serious about the fight for food than anyone else. They were the ones who called on [Fate] to stop Kim Dokja.

There's no way those guys would just sit by and watch us, who defeated ten 'historical-grade Constellations'.

The intervals between thunder sounds, as if representing our anxiety, were becoming shorter and shorter.

I asked, swallowing my ominousness.

'Are they going to deploy additional Constellations?'

<Asgard> would have suffered enormous losses just by bringing in 'Ginnungagap'.

I wanted to believe that no matter how large the Nebula was, it would be difficult to sustain any further damage.

—It would be nice if not...

['Bookmark' is released.]

['Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is temporarily disabled.]

With a tremendous recoil, my vision darkened as if a fuse had blown, but slowly recovered.

Anna Croft helped me as I stumbled.

"Cheon Inho? Are you okay? Cheon Inho!"

I nodded at her and stood upright with her support.

"What is this, what happened in 'Ginnungagap'?"

"I’ll explain later, but for now, Yoo Joonghyuk—"

The moment I said that, light sparks flew throughout my body and my vitality returned, albeit slightly.

['Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is activated again!]

—Additional probability was paid.

Additional probability?

—Something seems wrong. Be careful, Youngest.

This 'scenario' is a scenario that balances the scales instead of causing repercussions.

The fact that extra probability arose on this side meant that someone other than us was using that much probability on the other side of the scale.

What appeared beyond the portal were incarnations in exotic costumes. Judging by the atmosphere they gave off, they seemed to be from the Balkan Peninsula or the

Mediterranean.

Anna Croft, who discovered them, greeted them first.

"Are they the Greeks incarnation?"

One of the group nodded.

"The scenario is already over. You can go back."

It was just as Anna Croft said.

[The current sub-scenario has ended.]

Yoo Joonghyuk, who became the Black Beast, has fallen, and the reward for the 'sub-scenario' is out.

It became Kim Dokja’s responsibility.

But now additional personnel have been dispatched?

It was a bad situation no matter who looked at it. In fact, instead of responding to Anna Croft's words, the guys quickly looked around.

"As expected, <Asgard> came first."

The man who found the fallen 'Valkyrie's Daughter' muttered, and the incarnations nearby helped.

"You bastards. Did you really use 'Ginnungagap'?"

"You paid that price just to deal with one incarnation?"

'Valkyrie’s Daughter' growled, her eyes wide.

[You guys. Who are you?]

The angry mantra uttered by 'Valkyrie’s Daughter' caused an uproar throughout the area.

However, despite the Constellation's attack, the incarnations seemed completely unfazed.

"It’s pathetic. Even after using 'Ginnungagap', you failed."

Clearly they were incarnations. However, no matter how you look at their tone, it was not like incarnations.

The enraged 'Valkyrie’s Daughter' spewed out her mantra once again.

[This is the area of <Asgard>! I don’t know who you guys are, but—]

The words of 'Valkyrie’s Daughter' could not continue. Because her head had already been cut off and sent flying away.

The Greek man who brushed off his bloody shamshir grinned, held her severed head and shook it.

"Good things must be shared, friend."

No matter how much strength is exhausted, it is a power that can cut down a Constellation that has 'half-strengthened' in one blow.

[The Constellation 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' grins.]

Thebes? Damn it. no way.

—I know what kind of guys they are.

[The Constellations of <Olympus> are looking at you.]

After <Asgard>, it's <Olympus>.

'I think they came looking for fragments too.'

—I guess there was a rumor that we were a good restaurant.

The incarnations that appeared were all incarnations of <Olympus>.

Looking at the flow of probability flowing around, it seems that the Constellations of Olympus are controlling the incarnations by raising the synchronization rate to the limit.

Kim Dokja borrowed my mouth and said something.

"You guys seem to be misunderstanding something, but this isn’t 'Holy Demon War' or 'Gigantomachia'."

Even if it is a scenario where the 'scale of probability' works, there is a degree.

If the weight that the scale cannot support rises, the scale will eventually break and the scenario will end in catastrophe.

"Are you all here just to be burned to death by lightning? No matter how absurd the odds are—"

As if to prove Kim Dokja's words, lightning flashed in the air.

However, a new portal was opening in the place where the lightning flashed.

There wasn't only one.

Incarnations wearing various costumes were popping out one after another from dozens of portals that opened simultaneously.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Ghost> are looking at you.]

<Ghost>.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Tree of Protection> are looking at you.]

<Tree of Protection>.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Vedas> are looking at you.]

...<Vedas>.

When I checked there, I heard Kim Dokja's voice.

—Youngest.

'Yes.'

We began to run away, carrying the fallen Yoo Joonghyuk on our backs.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 711 Episode 26 Star Ladder (7)

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A space painted in neutral colors.

There was a white board with a boring design hanging there.

Kim Dokja Company

Lee Gilyoung stared at the writing on the board.

On the board, traces of various people's handwriting remained as they had been written and erased.

When Han Sooyoung first wrote these words, Lee Jihye asked:

She said, "But wasn’t our company disbanded?"

Han Sooyoung, who heard those words, muttered, "That makes a lot of sense," and corrected the handwriting.

<Han Sooyoung Company, formerly Kim Dokja Company>

Then Lee Seolhwa tilted her head.

"Wasn’t it Han Sooyoung Corporation?"

Han Sooyoung tilted her head and asked, "Did I lose that memory the last time I created an [Avatar]?"

While she was muttering this, each member of the group holding a pen wrote different words on the board.

<Company looking for Kim Dokja ahjussi>

<Kim Dokja Therapy Company>

<Kim Dokja Collection Company>

<Kim Dokja ★ Company>

<Kim Dokja Lee Gilyoung Company>

Someone laughed and someone else corrected what someone wrote.

As they erased and erased it again and again, the white board became dirty, like melted snow.

「"Joonghyuk-ssi, is there anything on your mind?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk glared pitifully at his companions as if he had no intention of getting involved and only looked out the window.

They wrote and erased it dozens of times.

Kim Dokja Company

In the end, those are the only words left to them. Those were the only words they were allowed to write.

Lee Gilyoung reached out to the blank space between 'Kim Dokja' and 'Company'. A blank space where only traces of what people wrote and erased countless times remain.

"Shin Yoosung. Should we not have done anything?"

Shin Yoosung did not respond and just like Lee Gilyoung, she stared blankly at the blank space between 'Kim Dokja' and 'Company'.

In that blank space was the history of their lives.

This was the 41st time she crossed the world lines to find Kim Dokja.

There, she met a new 'Kim Dokja'.

Interfering with the world line to change the story of the 41st round.

And...

Lee Seolhwa stuck her head out through the wide open door. Yoo Sangah, who looked a little tired, was also there.

Lee Gilyoung suddenly stood up and asked.

"Noonas. How did it go?"

"What about Sooyoung?"

It's already been a week since they lost connection with the 41st round.

It was only a week, but they had no idea how long a week here would be over there.

"Certainly not, right?"

Unlike them, Han Sooyoung did not go through the 'Story Connector' created by Lee Seolhwa, but directly infiltrated the '41st round'.

There, she used enormous probability and opened up the story, and as a result, saved Lee Hakhyun, the 49% Kim Dokja.

And.

"Sooyoung was in an avatar."

Han Sooyoung's avatar rescued Lee Hakhyun and disappeared.

"Even if the avatar dies, it’s okay as long as her main body doesn’t die."

Among her group, Han Sooyoung is the only one who can change [Avatars] freely.

She is a person who understands 'Ways of Survival' and this world better than anyone else.

Han Sooyoung left her own body here just in case.

Even if something unpleasant happens in the 41st round, she will be able to regain consciousness here.

But why?

"Why isn’t she waking up?"

After the 41st round’s 'Absolute Throne' scenario ended, Han Sooyoung did not wake up.

At first, they thought she might be secretly moving around using an [Avatar] somewhere.

But even after a day, two days, and a week, Han Sooyoung did not wake up.

More precisely,

"Why can’t I feel anything from Sooyoung?"

They didn’t feel her story.

What that meant was clear.

In the <Star Stream>, existence is a 'story'.

But her story stopped—

"She’ll be alive."

Yoo Sangah said.

"She must be alive. You know what kind of person Sooyoung is."

What kind of person is Han Sooyoung?

Neither Shin Yoosung nor Lee Gilyoung could easily answer that question anymore.

They’re not sure if the Kim Dokja they knew was really Kim Dokja.

What were they looking at in Kim Dokja? Did they look after each other properly?

"What about the black one?"

To make matters worse, Yoo Joonghyuk also lost contact. As expected, the last contact was immediately after the 'Absolute Throne' scenario.

It's time for him to come back, but why is there no contact at all?

[The 'Story Connector' responds to the flood of probability!]

The companions simultaneously raised their heads at the sudden message.

[An extra probability has arisen in the world line!]

Extra probability. They knew what that meant without anyone explaining it to them.

"I want to connect."

They didn't know why, but a margin of 'probability' has emerged in the world.

In other words, now it is possible to interfere in the 41st round with minimal cost.

"I told you I was going this time."

Shin Yoosung radiated her murderous spirit towards Lee Gilyoung, who growled.

Yoo Sangah said, trying to dissuade the two children who seemed ready to fight.

"I'll go."

"Not noona! We have to keep noona here."

"No, I just have to go and summon the bugs! Just wipe out the Constellations or whatever __"

It was Lee Seolhwa who interrupted their conversation.

"Someone is already using probability."

That couldn't have been possible.

The flood of probability has just occurred, so who on earth is already using probability?

The group looked at each other at the same time.

The first to open her mouth was Yoo Sangah.

"An analogy. Show me the area where the probability flooding occurred."

A sound was heard from somewhere, and a moment later a screen appeared.

"Sooty bastard!"

Beyond the screen, there was Yoo Joonghyuk confronting the Constellations.

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Immediately after failing to conquer the Void Curtain, Yoo Joonghyuk hid in the nearby and bided his time.

There were hunting dogs who chased him for interfering with the world line, but fortunately he had one useful companion.

—Damn it! You dude, you brought me here to take care of this mess.

A man named 'Jaehwan' brought from the ≪Imaginary Tree≫ worldview.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who entrusted the 'Hounds Chasing the Abyss' to him, hid his existence with the minimum probability and waited for an opportunity.

Normally, he would not have continued to wait so inefficiently.

But this time things were a little special.

'Han Sooyoung!'

Immediately after Han Sooyoung disappeared, something broke through the void curtain and entered the 41st round.

Yoo Joonghyuk immediately recognized what it was.

'Kim Dokja.'

It was definitely Kim Dokja.

At least a very large part of Kim Dokja that he remembered.

So Yoo Joonghyuk waited.

He doesn't know why, but Kim Dokja appeared right after Han Sooyoung disappeared.

If it is really clear that 'Kim Dokja' is beyond that ‘Void Curtain’.

If that 'Kim Dokja' is really the Kim Dokja he remembered,

"That guy will definitely distort 'probability' at least once."

Yoo Joonghyuk believed it and waited.

He waited and waited, enduring the shattering of his stories and the wear and tear of his memories.

And.

[The Great Tale 'Ginnungagap' begins its storytelling.]

Finally the signal came.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was behind the moon, immediately checked the state of the Earth for the 41st round.

The Earth was covered with a void veil, so it was impossible to see inside.

But it was possible to know what was happening.

The Giant Tale 'Ginnungagap'.

If the grand narrative of <Asgard> was moving at this point, it was definitely related to Kim Dokja.

Because it couldn't have happened without him doing something strange.

[The scales of probability have tipped!]

[Additional probability abound!]

Yoo Joonghyuk ran across space. The explosive narrative accelerated his entire body. This would have been impossible under normal circumstances. Because there was no probability allowed for him anymore.

But this 'scenario' was different.

[In this scenario, the 'balance of probability' rule is in effect.]

In this scenario, someone can intervene as long as they tip the scales first.

He can ignore the laws of probability and interfere with the scenario.

[What are you—]

At that moment, one of the Constellations that was trying to enter the void curtain using the power of their Nebula was grabbed by the neck by Yoo Joonghyuk.

The Constellation that had been intoxicated by Yoo Joonghyuk struggled and spewed out in anger. Perhaps it was a Constellation related to fire, but flames oozed from its red-hot incarnation.

Of course, Yoo Joonghyuk didn’t even flinch.

"Is this a great person?"

Yoo Junghyuk silently grabbed the guy by the neck and exploded his story. The Constellation was completely reduced to powder along with the incarnation body. The story that was once part of the Constellation crashed into the veil and broke into fragments.

Yoo Joonghyuk quietly looked down at the scattered remains of the Constellation and opened his mouth.

"Stop hiding and come out, you scum."

Subsequently, the incarnations of the Constellations hiding nearby appeared. It seemed like everyone had witnessed the previous battle, as their expressions had hardened.

[Hey, who was that guy who just died?]

[Guardian of the Little Horn.]

[He was a Constellation who was about to be promoted... but he was defeated in one hit?]

Yoo Joonghyuk lightly circulated his magic power and checked his condition.

Perhaps because he stayed in the other world for too long, his story did not listen to what he wanted.

'I can't even use half my power.'

His body is a mess. A state in which even his story does not listen. Still, this is enough to fight.

At least he can prevent the Constellations from intervening in the 41st round.

And if he’s lucky, he might be able to find a way to get under the Void Curtain.

"<Asgard>. Why did you appear here?"

The Constellations were startled by Yoo Joonghyuk's voice and trembled.

"Answer me. Why was 'Ginnungagap' activated? Earth is only in the seventh scenario, so why did you decide to intervene?"

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk took a step closer, a small twisting occurred in the distant universe.

As the interstellar world swirled, space-time repeatedly contracted and expanded.

The nearby Constellations sighed and retreated.

[Oh, here it comes—]

Yoo Joonghyuk also felt it.

Something was coming here.

Very old and powerful beings.

[The Constellation 'Goddess of Love and Cats' is staring at you!]

A terrifying threat swirled before his eyes, and before he knew it, four Constellations arrived in front of Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The Constellation 'God of the Harp and Horn' is showing hostility towards you.]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Lost His Arm to the Wolf of Destruction' frowns!]

[The Constellation 'Guardian of the Great Fire Bridge' warns you.]

Narrative-grade Constellations representing <Asgard>.

After recognizing them, the other Constellations shouted.

[Seoul, the Narrative-grade Constellations—!]

[I can't believe it.]

Freya, the Goddess of Love and Cats.

Bragi, God of the Harp and Horn.

Tyr, The One Who Lost His Arm to the Wolf of Destruction.

Heimdall, Guardian of the Great Fire Bridge.

They were all Constellations of <Asgard> equivalent to the 12 gods of <Olympus>. The most powerful Constellations and beings that are difficult to even encounter.

Four such Constellations appeared at the same time.

What is even more shocking than that is,

[Are you the discarded puppet of the Oldest Dream?]

[Just as I heard from my father, you have great momentum.]

It is only after the appearance of the four Narrative-grade Constellations representing <Asgard> that the collapsed balance of the 'scale' gradually returned to its proper place.

[Are you really saying that one guy is like the four of us?]

The person who stepped forward with a frown was Tyr, 'The One Who Lost His Arm to the Wolf of Destruction'. Tyr, who inherited the blood of a giant and had a large body, approached Yoo Joonghyuk, revealing his story without hesitation.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at Tyr and muttered.

"It’s smaller than Master."

[What?]

The moment Tyr asked back, Yoo Joonghyuk took a step forward.

Two steps, three steps.

It was just a walk.

But why?

Tyr felt an inexplicable tremor as he watched Yoo Joonghyuk approaching through the void.

He had felt this same tremor a long time ago.

He couldn't believe it. He is a Narrative-grade Constellation. It was also a Narrative-grade Constellation located at the top of <Asgard>.

The being he fears is the 'Wolf of Destruction' that bit his arm.

And it was only his father who was greater than any other star in the world.

"Do you want the rest of your arm cut off too?"

The moment when Yoo Joonghyuk slowly drew his sword.

Rumbling.

A terrifying wave rang out from across the universe. A sound like thunder from very far away.

If you hit it the right way, no matter how strong Yoo Joonghyuk is, he won't be safe from it.

Something also flashed across Yoo Joonghyuk’s expression. Because he knew who the owner of lightning was.

[The Constellation 'One-Eyed Father' is glaring at you.]

One-Eyed Father.

The strongest Mythical Constellation in <Asgard>, Odin.

Although he did not intervene directly, the Mythical Constellation expressed his opinion.

Coo coo coo coo.

An explosion was heard from beyond the void curtain. Perhaps something was happening over there as well.

"Is it."

Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Black Heavenly Demon' was dyed in bright golden light.

"If you want to go down, I’ll drop you all."

The stars moved with the signal. A huge cluster of meteor showers hitting together.

The story of the Constellations and the trajectory of Breaking the Sky swordsmanship became intertwined, and the sky of the <Star Stream> became dazzlingly colored.

Stars began to fall from the night sky.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 712 Episode 26 Star Ladder (8)

The sky was changing in real time. It was pitch black, then white, then there was thunder, then rain.

On the other side of an unpredictable weather event, beyond the swaying void curtain, supreme beings were shaking the universe.

What on earth is going on over there?

Has Yoo Joonghyuk really appeared and is grabbing the Constellations and stomping them?

—Oh, Youngest. There's a piece of story of quality falling over there.

41st round Yoo Joonghyuk’s head hung on my shoulder.

I couldn't figure out what was really going on.

If the being over there is really Yoo Joonghyuk, why didn't he appear here in the form of a possessed person like Shin Yoosung? Just as Shin Yoosung used herself in the 41st round, he could also use himself in the 41st round.

—That’s bullshit. If that kid comes here, he'll be in big trouble.

'Why? If Yoo Joonghyuk comes, we can wipe them all out, right?'

—Why do you think Yoo Joonghyuk will help us?

For a moment, I felt a tingling sensation in the back of my head. As I was only thinking about Shin Yoosung's case, I forgot for a moment what the original purpose of <Kim Dokja Company> was.

According to Han Sooyoung’s memories, the purpose of <Kim Dokja Company> is to retrieve Kim Dokja.

Maybe my presence was a distraction to them.

—It would be nice if the Earth didn't explode like this.

'No, but still...'

I always think about it, but Kim Dokja's impression of Yoo Joonghyuk was a bit crooked. How could Yoo Joonghyuk have even done something like that?

Still, it was true that I was worried at the same time.

If, like Han Sooyoung, Yoo Joonghyuk also tries to get Kim Dokja back in the form of 'quickly destroying this world'...

—But shouldn’t you run fast?

Right. Now is not the time to leisurely think about such things.

Because even now, the incarnations of the Giant Nebulae were chasing me in real time.

"Tear off his legs!"

"Tear him limb from limb!"

Why on earth are they running and saying things like that?

Anyway, I just think that I should never get caught. But I quickly ran out of breath.

—You need to do some exercise.

'It's refreshing to hear something like that from someone who was born weak.'

—You can’t do that. Let's borrow it one more time.

[Stage 3 of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is strongly activated!]

I seemed to feel a stronger overlap with Kim Dokja, and [Way of the Wind] wrapped around my toes, covering over a hundred meters in an instant.

In reality, if I had competed in the Olympics, I would have set a new record right away, but right now, even this wasn't enough.

[The character 'Alexander Mihailidis' activates the exclusive skill 'High-Speed Driving Lv.6'!]

[The character 'Leila Al Hasan' activates the exclusive skill 'Runaway Lv.8'!]

These guys are really persistent.

'Constellation-nim! Back! Back!'

A dizzying sensation felt in the back of the head. As Kim Dokja reflexively twisted his head, a breathtaking beam of light passed by his earlobe.

Arrow? Or a spear?

Anyway, if I had been a little late, I would have had a hole in the back of my head.

'Left!'

The moment he urgently changed direction, an arrow aimed at a blind spot hit his thigh. Fortunately, it was not me who was hit, but Kim Dokja.

—You said it's on the left? It came from the right!

'It looks like it came from the right too!'

Kim Dokja pulled out the arrow and fired the broken arrow behind him.

The sound of an arrow loaded with [Way of the Wind] piercing something was heard, and a scream rang out.

But neither Kim Dokja nor I looked back.

—Youngest. That.

I checked the ladder hanging in the sky.

'Star Ladder.'

It was the road leading to the 'eighth scenario' that I checked as soon as I arrived in the eastern Washington area.

'You said I shouldn't use that?'

—No way, surviving is the priority now.

'How do you use it?'

Instead of answering, Kim Dokja raised his right hand with all his might and shouted.

"I call the Star Ladder!"

It's simple, I think.

['Star Ladder' does not respond to you.]

Damn it, then that's right.

There is no way the scenario with Kim Dokja would be that smooth.

What was absurd was that, except for us, all other incarnations were moving on to the next scenario through the 'Star Ladder'.

"Jump out! If you get caught up in here, you'll die!"

"I will call the Star Ladder!"

The incarnations ran away to the next scenario through the 'Star Ladder' amidst a proliferation of Giant Nebulae.

Although the shape, size, and degree of damage to each ladder were different, the ladders came down to everyone except us.

'Why can't we just come down the ladder?'

Perhaps Kim Dokja was in the midst of looking into it, too, when he faintly heard a message from a conversation with Bihyung in his head.

—Constellation. So now... with authority...

Authority?

[The Constellations with permission to use the 'Star Ladder' are not responding to you.]

[The right to use the 'Star Ladder' is limited to some Constellations that contributed to the creation of the 'Recycling Center'.]

I don't know exactly what you're talking about, but anyway, it seems impossible for anyone to lower the ladder.

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' frowns, wondering what the hell that means.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' asks what the 'Recycling Center' is.]

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is complaining that the 'Star Stream's System' seems to have become more difficult these days.]

I'm glad I'm not the only one who's stupid.

I asked Kim Dokja without any expectations.

'Constellation-nim. Don't you have ladder permission?'

—What do you think?

'Do you have a friend I could ask for?'

—What do you think?

'So what happens now?'

—Just wait a moment.

'They all came after me?'

Before I knew it, the incarnations were forming a circle and narrowing the siege.

Incarnations of <Olympus>, <Ghost>, <Guardian Tree>, and <Vedas>.

"We've caught him! Surround him slowly!"

Judging from what it felt like, there were no people with Narrative-grade sponsors.

They are all incarnations of Historical-grade Constellations.

These were all guys who had raised their synchronization rate to the limit.

This scenario is subject to the rules of 'probability'. However, if the number of Constellations that raised the synchronization rate to the limit increased, it was normal for the scale to naturally fall out of balance.

'If this is the case, shouldn't someone come help us?'

Yoo Joonghyuk, or even another member <Kim Dokja Company> since Kim Dokja said no for Yoo Joonghyuk earlier.

At least one person can come.

—Do you think a hundred bugs weigh the same as a lion?

I realized how great <Kim Dokja Company> had become.

What a bug. Still, those guys are also Constellations of their own.

—Giant Nebulae aren't stupid either. It's all calculated based on probability. The proof is that there are so many incarnations, but they don't have any Narrative-grade sponsor.

Does that mean they are also adjusting the probability in their own way?

I sighed lightly and counted their numbers. Even at first glance, their number is well over thirty.

On the other hand, this side was now at its limit.

My body, strengthened with 'Dragon Heart', was reduced to rags as soon as it was used with the power of Cheok Jungyeong, and [Bookmark]’s time limit was exhausted.

If that Thebes were to stab me with the tip of a spear, my body would collapse. Now the only one I can trust is Kim Dokja.

—Youngest.

'Yes.'

—Earn some time and say something.

'Huh?'

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' Lv.3 is deactivated.]

It was absurd.

No, if you leave it like this, what will happen to me?

I hurriedly thought of 'Thoughts of Almost Everything'.

What items are useful right now?

The 'Poison Bomb' has already been used up so there is no more, so should we try hiding using the 'Everchanging Stealth Suit'?

Or should I at least use [Incite]?

Fortunately, the incarnations that were closing the distance stopped with about ten meters left.

Looking closely, I saw that they were also keeping each other in check.

One of the incarnations, who had been spewing out threats and killing intent to me, opened his mouth first.

"<Olympus>. You didn’t forget your promise, right?"

Looking at the Halloween party-like costume, it is an incarnation belonging to <Ghost>. The answer was the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' from <Olympus>.

"Don’t worry. You’ll get your share as well. The Mythical-grade Constellations have just concluded an agreement."

When the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' answered, the incarnations of <Ghost> looked at me.

"Then everyone shares equally."

Share? What do you share?

You should ask my opinion too, you bastards.

As I watched the guys approaching me step by step, I gathered my strength once again.

I felt like I was relying too much on my sponsor.

Now I have to do some work too.

"I am Kim Dokja."

I began, slightly twisting my lips.

"A lot of people have gathered. But what happened in your 'Ginnungagap' and is it like this?"

"Don’t listen to him. He’s just trying to kill time. Now—"

"Aren’t you curious? Why did 'Valkyrie’s Daughter' end up like that?"

"At most, he dealt with one Historical-grade..."

After all, these guys don’t know everything.

I grinned and snapped my fingers in the air. Of course, I didn't have to snap my fingers, but I did it anyways.

"Now, for the first time in the <Star Stream>, the inside of 'Ginnungagap' is revealed."

[The story of a tale whose name has not yet been decided begins!]

My story, whose name has not yet been revealed, began to speak. Then, as if they had been waiting, I heard a message from the Constellations.

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is viewing the tale!]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is viewing the tale!]

[The Constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' is viewing the tale!]

[A few Constellations are surprised after reading your story!]

Originally, 'Ginnungagap' was a stage where no records of any stories were left.

However, I was able to leave a story safely thanks to the effect of 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear’.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are astonished.]

[The Nebula <Asgard> requests the management to restrict access to the records!]

The truth about 'Ginnungagap' is spreading widely.

<Asgard>'s disgraceful behavior to catch me was quickly spreading throughout the <Star Stream>.

<Asgard> belatedly started to block it, but the Constellations had already read the story that was heard infrequently.

"Gatekeeper of Thebes, is that true?"

One of the incarnations of the <Guardian Tree>, who had been silent the entire time, asked.

"That guy took care of ten historical-grade Constellations who used half-descent?"

"It doesn’t make sense… It can’t be like that."

"Didn’t 'Valkyrie’s Daughter' go out alone?"

Some incarnations take a step back. A hole was opened in the circular siege of the incarnations.

I could vividly feel the stirring of the Constellations.

I didn't miss the opportunity and took a step forward.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated.]

"Now you know who you guys are dealing with."

The surprised incarnations took a step back one after another.

'Gatekeeper of Thebes', who realized that the atmosphere was unusual, shouted.

"It’s bullshit! Don’t be fooled! Even if that story is true, he has already used up all of his strength in 'Ginnungagap'. If we join forces and kill him now—"

I burst out laughing. The gatekeeper of Thebes silently fell silent due to that maniacal laughter.

"It seems like you didn’t understand even though I gave you a chance."

"You, what—"

"I killed ten historical-grade Constellations in the seventh scenario. And the story I’ve accumulated hasn’t been given a 'name' yet. Don’t you know what this means?"

I saw a few quick-witted incarnations rolling their eyes.

An unnamed tale.

In other words, my story wasn't 'complete' yet.

"If you help me here, you will be able to receive a share of the tale I will receive."

[A very small number of Constellations are surprised by the proposal of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' admires your tongue.]

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is interested in your remarks.]

A confused silence fell among the bustling Constellations.

They came here to join forces to eliminate the 'Demon King of Salvation' and obtain 'Kim Dokja's Fragment'.

However, looking at their expressions, the majority of people here did not yet understand exactly what 'Kim Dokja's Fragment' was.

"Choose. Either attack me foolishly and get kicked out of the scenario without even getting your money's worth."

They now have another option.

"Or maybe you will join hands with me and share a story that is definitively 'legendary' or higher."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 713 Episode 26 Star Ladder (9)

Either attack me and act foolishly, or take my side and get a 'legendary story'.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor performance increases.]

Although I spoke quite like Kim Dokja, in fact, I was not naive enough to believe that this alone would persuade the Constellations.

"Everyone, don’t be fooled! This is an issue that the Mthical Constellations have already agreed upon!"

Anyway, they all belong to a 'Giant Nebula'.

As the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' said, if the 'Mythical Constellations' had truly agreed on this issue, there was no way that a mere historical-grade could refuse the order.

"There is no guarantee that you will receive a legendary story by collaborating with that guy in the first place. Rather, the story you’ll get by killing him will be much more valuable."

"I see, that’s true."

"Then let’s kill him quickly without hesitation."

I slowly bit my lip.

I have to somehow wait until Kim Dokja comes.

It certainly seems that the Constellations are not stupid.

"You guys are cowardly."

Hmm?

"Are those who have the Giant Nebula on their backs persecuting just one incarnation?"

There was one fool.

Red flowing hair. A woman holding a Japanese sword embossed with a calm flame was blocking my path.

'Asuka Ren?'

It was the representative incarnation of the Japanese side.

I wondered why she was helping me, but her gaze briefly rested on Yoo Joonghyuk hanging on my shoulder.

Now that I think about it, I heard that Yoo Joonghyuk helped Asuka Ren clear 'Peace Land''in the 41st round.

Perhaps Asuka Ren is trying to repay the debt.

—Take the Supreme King and run away.

With [Transmission], the Japanese incarnations, led by Asuka Ren, lined up in front of me.

"Are they the incarnations of the East? They look like they want to die. Are they out of their minds?"

The Gatekeeper of Thebes smiled, but Asuka Ren did not smile. A quiet magic bloomed from her whole body. The sincere story she had built up through consistent effort was felt in her whole body.

"You are the one who needs to come to your senses. Did you go into a Giant Nebula just to do something like that?"

"What—"

"I am speaking to the 'incarnations' here."

Asuka Ren's eyes sparkled.

The people she was talking to were not the Constellations, but the incarnations that were controlled by the Constellations.

"Alexander! Leila! We cleared the sub-scenario together. I remember you from back then. Have you already forgotten your promise to survive to the end of the world and meet again?"

I once again realized what kind of person Asuka Ren was in 'Peace Land'.

She is someone who chose the 'little people' camp even when faced with the easy option of 'disaster'.

"Come to your senses. If you are ruled by the Constellations now, you will forever be—"

"An insignificant incarnation who is so arrogant."

The 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' jabbed at her and three incarnations rushed towards her at the same time.

An old sword, a broken spear, a club.

Looking at the weapons used as main weapons, it seemed like it was a case of medieval knights or barbarians who gained status and became Constellations.

However, whether they are knights, barbarians, bastards, once they ascend to Constellations, they become beings on a different level.

Coo coo coo coo.

As the story of the historical-grade Constellation, whose synchronization rate increased, was revealed, the wide-eyed incarnations came screaming and waving their weapons. A blow that would shatter the limbs of an ordinary incarnation.

However, 'Asuka Ren' was not an ordinary incarnation.

「She is one of the '100 strongest people' in Ways of Survival.」

Her blade flashed in her hand as she dodged the flying club. A strike like a holy war. At first glance, the speed was reminiscent of Lee Jihye's skill.

"Ugh—"

The incarnation, whose club was broken, staggered and grabbed her own neck. Fush-shist, blood bursting out. The incarnation, foaming with her blood, fell to her knees.

Asuka Ren looked down at the incarnation and spoke in a calm voice.

"I avoided the critical point."

Before we knew it, faint sparks were fluttering all over Asuka Ren's body.

[The incarnation 'Asuka Ren' increases the synchronization rate with her sponsor.]

Belatedly, the expression of the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' changed.

"No way, her sponsor is—"

[The Constellation 'Goryeo’s First Sword' is interested.]

Her Constellation is Japan's strongest swordsman.

[The Constellation 'Two Thousand Top Masters' is glaring at the Constellations of the Giant Nebula.]

The Master of Icheon Ilryu, 'Miyamoto Musashi'.

As a cold, murderous feeling spread from Asuka Ren's entire body, the expressions of those who were frightened stiffened and they retreated.

Even among the same 'historical-grade', there is a level of rank. While there are Constellations that are close to the level of historical-grade, there are also Constellations that have just reached historical-grade.

'Icheon Ilryu Master' was a Constellation closer to the former.

"Stand back, Gatekeeper."

It was then that a voice came from behind the group of incarnations.

"A warrior from the East. A swordsmaster who made a lot of fuss. I wanted to try it for once."

As the Gatekeeper of Thebes hesitated and retreated, a man with bronze red hair and a strong presence stepped forward. At first glance, it was a Constellation with a more powerful status than the Gatekeeper of Thebes.

[The Constellation 'Sorrows of Troy' increases the synchronization rate with the incarnation.]

Behind him, another giant was radiating a formidable force.

[The Constellation 'Wrath of Ithaca' makes an interested expression.]

The 'Sorrows of Troy' and the 'Wrath of Ithaca'.

They were 'Achilles' and 'Odysseus', the heroes of『Iliad』.

Even within <Olympus>, they are great Constellations of a different rank.

Asuka Ren’s expression was tense.

—Take the Supreme King and run away. I can escape at any time.

It seems that Japan has already secured a Constellation to support the 'Star Ladder'.

—Now!

"I’ll take care of you."

With Asuka Ren's signal, the temple flashed and one side of the siege was breached.

"He’s running away!"

Miyamoto Musashi and Achilles collided and magical energy exploded.

I ran with all my might, carrying Yoo Joonghyuk on my back, avoiding the swords flying from all directions.

However, there was no way I could run away for that long as I did not have any useful light attack skills.

"Cheon Inho! This way!"

With a screeching sound, a sports car stopped, leaving skid marks.

Without hesitation, I threw Yoo Joonghyuk into the back seat and got in.

As Anna Croft, who was behind the wheel, stepped on the accelerator, Christina waved her chin in greeting.

"Selena was sent up because her injuries were severe."

"What about you?"

It was a question that didn't need to be asked.

They delayed using the 'Star Ladder' to save me.

Honestly, I was moved.

Because they were the incarnations of <Asgard>.

"If you help me here, <Asgard> won’t leave you alone."

"We’re doomed because of you, anyway."

Anna Croft gritted her teeth and answered.

"Because of the story you revealed..."

It occurred to me later that I had revealed the events in 'Ginnungagap'.

Inside 'Ginnungagap', Anna Croft processed the 'Lesser Dragon Heart' for me, and with her help, I was able to wipe out the Constellations.

Anna Croft must have helped in 'Ginnungagap' because she believed in the characteristics of 'Ginnungagap', which leaves no records, but since I made the story public, her actions have now become known throughout the <Star Stream>.

"It’s not just that they suffered losses. They also probably gained a lot of benefits thanks to you."

"You’re saying that now—"

Anna Croft roared. She seemed really angry, so I felt a little sorry.

"What did Asgard say?"

"Nothing yet. They seem to be busy right now too."

Thunder crashing down from the sky without stopping. Seeing as the meteor shower has been falling for several minutes now, it seems like they won't be paying attention to us right now.

"Why didn’t you use the Star Ladder? You would have already met the qualifications—"

"There were no Constellations willing to send a ladder."

"Are you sure you haven’t made friends with the Constellations of the 'Recycling Center'?"

An arrow flew from behind and lodged in the trunk with a loud noise.

Anna stepped on the accelerator harder.

"I will go to the outskirts of the dome. Use the valuable portal there. If you return to Korea, you will be able to avoid their pursuit."

"Is this why you are helping us like this?"

"I hate to admit it, but I need you to see the end of this world."

Anna Croft still believes that I am 'Cheon Inho of the 40th round'.

But there was something I didn't understand with that alone.

No matter how great Cheon Inho was in the 40th round, he was a villain. Although I said I would help Yoo Joonghyuk, is it possible for the Prophet Anna Croft to trust me based on such a weak promise?

"Please calm down, Cheon Inho."

"What do you mean?"

"Exactly what scenario did you go to in the last round?"

I was momentarily taken aback.

What does that mean?

"I know that you didn’t die even after Yoo Joonghyuk regressed."

I remembered seeing Anna Croft's [Future Sight].

In the 40th round, the final showdown between Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho.

The final scene where the stars in the sky fell and the world approached destruction.

"How many scenarios did you go to after that? In that world where all incarnations disappeared, you…"

Goosebumps slowly appeared.

That memory wasn't the last scene of the 40th round?

Looking back, Cheon Inho's death was not properly described in her memory.

So does that mean that Cheon Inho continued to live even after Yoo Joonghyuk regressed?

"Cheon—"

Anna Croft's words did not last until the end. This is because a lightning strike that fell from thin air directly hit the bonnet of the car.

My body was lifted up with a loud noise, and the shock of my bones being torn apart swept through my entire body.

I rolled around on the dirt floor, holding onto Yoo Joonghyuk tightly.

When I stood up, coughing and spitting out dust, I saw Anna and Christina who had collapsed.

'Constellation-nim.'

Instead of Kim Dokja's answer, all that was heard was the harsh sound of lightning. Lightning was striking continuously across the dark sky.

A much bigger shock than what was witnessed in 'Ginnungagap'.

Due to the deafening weather change, the fire gods that were chasing us suddenly stopped walking. The number of falling meteor showers was increasing in real time.

At this point, even I was scared.

What on earth is Yoo Joonghyuk doing over there?

Is he planning to destroy the <Star Stream> like this?

Is this an intention to summon an Outer God?

At that moment, a question arose.

Yoo Joonghyuk intervened in this world line.

This was possible because the Giant Nebulae were using equivalent probability on the other side of the scale.

However, 'Ginnungagap' has already been lifted. Although the pursuers caught up, the only ones who appeared here were historical-grade Constellations with high synchronization rates.

So where on earth are the Giant Nebulae using 'probability'?

My heart was pounding loudly and I had an ominous feeling.

Sentences began to appear in my head.

「The Giant Nebulae know.」

<Asgard> knew.

「What kind of being is the Demon King of Salvation? What kind of stories has he built up?」

The distant sky split and lightning struck once again.

I slowly became out of breath. Something was happening that shouldn't have happened.

It feels like a distant sense of the causality of time being distorted. It feels like the whole world is looking into me.

[The Constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' shouts in anger!]

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' warns you!]

[The Constellation 'Bald General of Justice'...]

Indirect messages from the Constellations echoed in my ears, distorting the air like a whirlpool.

Only then did I realize what the 'Giant Nebula' had done.

[The Giant Nebula <Asgard> has announced a new 'Fate'.]

An order that cannot be resisted.

The probability of stars that a mere mortal cannot escape no matter how hard he struggles.

「...It is.」

My [Fate] was being written down.

「...I will die.」

The very moment when the inevitability of the stars was imprinted on my soul along with nausea.

—Youngest.

I felt like someone was pushing my soul hard.

—I'm resting now.

I screamed as I felt the pressure of the world disappear. Because I realized what was about to happen.

It can't be.

Not this time.

You are-

—Because I'm good at this.

At the last moment, I felt like I saw Kim Dokja's brightly smiling face.

「The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' will die in the story he loved.」

Destiny is decided.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 714 Episode 26 Star Ladder (10)

As my vision narrowed, I realized what was about to happen.

「The Demon King of Salvation wants to sacrifice himself.」

The situation is desperate. The Washington Dome was under siege by historical-grade Constellations, and there was no Constellation to help us.

To make matters worse, he was sentenced by [Fate].

Kim Dokja made a decision in a situation where death was inevitable no matter what he did.

Only through his death can this obstacle be overcome.

'Stop!'

But I couldn't leave it like that.

This is my [Fate]. It's my share to bear.

'Stop!'

There is no reason why the Demon King of Salvation should receive it instead.

'Kim Dokja!'

—You're not ready to fight them yet.

I felt like someone was supporting me.

I turned my head and saw Christina Page.

Just as I was about to say thank you, my eyes met hers with a faint hint of guilt. Her fingers moved with an ominous foreboding.

My vision went dark.

---

Christina Page.

Anna Croft's closest associate who leads 'Zarathustra'.

She is an FBI forensic hypnosis expert and is called 'Finger Snapper' in 'Ways of Survival'.

Just before she possessed this character, Olivia was playing TRPG with her friends.

'Kevin, Jim, Amelia.'

Olivia thought about her own friends.

She had friends who liked subculture.

Kevin only read webtoons with 'SSS' in the title.

Jim loved martial arts novels.

Amelia loved virtual idols.

'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' was a Korean web novel brought by Kevin.

—Guys, how are we supposed to survive once we enter this novel?

—Oh, Kevin. It's starting again.

—This is set in Korea. I think we'll be at a bit of a disadvantage.

—No, America is also included.

—Kevin, but the title of this novel doesn’t include 'SSS'?

— As you read, SSS appears. Olivia, can you write an email to the author? You said before that you have a Korean friend. Let's add this novel's world view in the next session.

What would it have been like if she hadn't listened to Kevin at that time?

If she hadn't sent the email to the author, all of this wouldn't have happened.

'Oh my God.'

It was sheer luck that she survived.

It turns out that the person who she possessed was 'Christina Page'.

She has always enjoyed playing TRPGs, so it wasn't difficult for her to play the role of 'Christina Page'. She was glad the task wasn't difficult.

Olivia was able to forget who she was, at least while she was playing 'Christina Page' .

—Demon King of Salvation.

She could forget Kevin, forget herself, forget Amelia, forget her dead friends.

—Can you really save my friends?

A message from the 'Demon King of Salvation' delivered through the exclusive skill, [Nightmare].

—Yes.

The Demon King of Salvation said.

If she grants his request, he will definitely save her dead friends.

And the request is—

[Exclusive skill 'Daily Invoice Lv.5' is activated!]

Christina hurriedly helped Cheon Inho, who fell in front of her.

She was startled to see Anna Croft stumbling in the distance.

"Christina! What are you doing?"

"It is the order of the Demon King of Salvation."

"What?"

"He told me to place a [Daily Invoice] on his incarnation."

"What the hell is that—"

She doesn't know why the Demon King of Salvation made such a request.

"It doesn’t matter. This person can ignore my [Daily Invoice] and move his incarnation."

She doesn't know, but she thought they were planning to use [Daily Invoice] to fight.

The strange thing is why he communicated directly through [Nightmare] rather than using his incarnation.

"Then why doesn’t Cheon Inho wake up? Last time he woke up right away."

"I know that too—"

It was then that a bright beam of light burst from the Capitol.

This was the area where the 'sub-scenario' occurred earlier.

The place where the fake 'Demon King of Salvation' and the ‘Black Beast’ appeared.

However, the false Demon King of Salvation was defeated, and Yoo Joonghyuk, who became the Black Beast, also fainted.

The scenario has already ended.

But why are sparks flying around the Capitol?

"Christina. The something is not right."

Dark clouds filled the sky and covered the Capitol.

A pitch-black thunderbolt falling between dark clouds.

[The 'Demon King of Salvation' is resurrected in the scenario.]

The demon king, who was thought to be dead, appeared in Washington.

---

The 'Dark Keeper', hugged in the warm abyss, thought.

「I.」

A question that has been asked for a very long time.

「Who am I?」

That moon gate was all that explained him. The answer he couldn't get even though he gave up all his resources.

In order to find it, the 'Dark Keeper' contracted with the Dokkaebi and became part of the scenario.

Nevertheless,

「I was not the Demon King of Salvation.」

He couldn't find the answer he wanted.

There couldn't be an exact answer.

The stars turned away from him and the script abandoned him.

He is just a nameless character.

Or a monster that didn't even become a character. A consumable to make the main character shine.

「That’s fine.」

He already knew that this world was a playground for Constellations. Even if it was just a sand castle that was built for a short time on the playground and then collapsed, he wanted to have his own name.

He wanted to be a proper part of the playground.

He wanted to become the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

—Do you really want to become the 'Demon King of Salvation'?

The 'Dark Keeper' looked up blankly at the Demon King of Salvation.

—Whatever the cost?

He wants to have a name.

He wants to have a proper role and die after fulfilling it.

The 'Dark Keeper' nodded with all his might.

He's good even if it's just one sentence, so if there's a story given to him.

—Then let’s give it a try.

He wants to write down that story.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its storytelling.]

The cold snow covered him.

「I.」

The dark sentinel soon became one with distant eternity.

「We are the Demon King of salvation.」

His tattered body was once again filled with probability and filled with the story of the Constellation.

Tsutsutsutsu!

In the midst of wild sparks, Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation', opened his eyes.

When he lightly tilted his head, his body screamed along with a crunching sound.

A demonic body full of traces of being cut to pieces by Yoo Joonghyuk.

Even though no limb was intact, it was important that the plan was successful.

[The Constellations of <Asgard> are astonished!]

A plan that was dramatically successful.

This could not have been realized if several probabilities had not been interlocked like cogs.

A Giant Nebula uttered [Fate].

That [Fate] was given to him, a Narrative-grade Constellation, instead of an incarnation.

The probability ran wild due to a calculation error in the twisted [Fate].

Under the pretext of extra probability, he was given the right to move to a new body.

Above all, the plan could not have succeeded if it had not been for the help of the demon 'Dark Keeper' who impersonated the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

[The incarnation body resonates with your story.]

[The synchronization rate between you and the incarnation body increases.]

Perhaps this will be his last story.

"It’s him! He’s over there!"

The incarnations who sensed his status began to flock to him.

The great Constellations belonging to the Giant Nebula that were chasing Lee Hakhyun just a moment ago.

"W-what is that—"

"Why in a body other than your own incarnation..."

"Could it be that you were trying to protect the incarnation?"

The Constellations looked at each other in disbelief.

Someone said with a sly smile.

"They say he’s a fragment of a discarded god, but he’s incredibly stupid."

Stupid.

That was correct.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Ghost> shake their heads at your foolishness.]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Guardian Tree> are saddened by your choice.]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> laugh at your judgment.]

The body of the resurrected demon species creaked. The word was resurrection, but the body was already dead. An incarnation that can't last even 10 minutes at best.

From afar, the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' shouted loudly.

"You've finally been caught, Demon King of Salvation! There's nowhere to run now!"

As if victory had already been achieved, the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' walked towards him with great strides and spoke in a triumphant voice.

"You have no idea how much effort I put into catching you. I persuaded the Nebulae one by one…"

Now that [Fate] has been declared, it will be difficult to avoid death.

The situation might have been a little better if there had been a story like 'I, the Opponent of Fate', and Cheok Junkyung's 'The One Who Fights Against Fate', which the 1,865th round of <Kim Dokja Company> had.

But there was no such story.

There were many stories that he does not have today.

「Maybe the Youngest will find everything.」

The Youngest was a strange guy.

Among the 'Kim Dokjas' he knows, he is the only one who can write.

He was curious at first.

He was curious about what the guy who possessed this petty villain would talk about.

The guy who clumsily imitated 'Kim Dokja' was cute, and he was a little proud of the guy who took care of the things that 'Kim Dokja' didn't do.

Sometimes he was so frustrated that he wanted to say something.

Still, it was fun to see the story of such a guy.

「But he’s the Youngest.」

Maybe that's why he's here now.

「This damned world won’t read the story you wrote.」

The 'Gatekeeper of Thebes', who had been talking for a while, frowned.

"...So, are you listening to my story?"

The Demon King of Salvation looked at him for a moment and laughed.

Among the tales of the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes', there was the 'Final Cubic Crystal'.

A tale that makes one confess one's desires at the last moment in exchange for raising one's status.

"Uh, go ahead."

While the 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' was talking, the Demon King of Salvation looked through the coat the demon servant was wearing.

There was a cigarette pack in the coat.

As he took out a cigarette, the thought of a person who liked cigarettes came to mind.

Who was it?

Memories dispersed like smoke. The place where the memories disappeared hurt. That pain immediately proved that he was Kim Dokja.

The 'Gatekeeper of Thebes', who came to his senses belatedly, blushed and shouted.

"Kill him! Retrieve the fragment!"

Incarnations rushing towards him.

The Demon King of Salvation said, tossing away his cigarette.

"Youngest, let me borrow some weapons."

Silver light flew from somewhere and settled in the right hand of the Demon King of Salvation.

[The tale 'The One Who is Loved by All Things' begins its storytelling.]

[The item 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' is suitable for your story.]

In a flash of bright light, one of the incarnations that was running at the front was split in half.

"Kaaaaaaak!"

'Thought' mimicked 'Broken Faith'.

'I activate 'Blade of Faith'.

"How can you still—"

The Constellations retreated in awe.

The power to kill the incarnation of a great Constellation with increased synchronization.

The 'Gatekeeper of Thebes', with his eyes wide open as if torn apart, screamed loudly.

"It’s just a fluke! Keep pushing! Even he’s at his limit!"

The hesitating Constellations rushed forward again.

The Demon King of Salvation swung his sword without hesitation. Cut off their arms, cut off their legs, and slit their throat.

Every time that happened, the wounds on the demon species' body also increased.

「This world is an obvious tragedy.」

He pulled out the arrow stuck in his shoulder and kicked away the spear that grazed his thigh.

「A world created to cause pain to Yoo Joonghyuk.」

The moment he removed the blade aimed at his side, a pain arose in his back. The torn wings of the demon species fluttered across the floor.

「A story marred by big and small failures and never-ending despair. This world was the fate given to Yoo Joonghyuk.」

The moment the torn wing fell to the ground, lightning struck again from the sky.

「Therefore, anyone who tries to share that responsibility will surely be cursed.」

The void curtain fluttered and another star fell into the white shining night sky.

[Some great fate is wishing for your death.]

He is the Demon King of Salvation who cannot feel emotions.

Nevertheless, at this moment, he was also Kim Dokja. Maybe it was because I met the Youngest.

"Hey. Are you fighting too, right?"

Yoo Joonghyuk couldn’t answer.

Just as the writing on the monitor does not respond.

Some communication never happens. And where communication is impossible, there is just a story.

「The Demon King of Salvation lives to read that story.」

The Demon King of Salvation smiled like a prisoner accepting a deserved punishment.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 715 Episode 26 Star Ladder (11)

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「"Die! Kill him somehow!"」

「"This guy has already been managed. We can defeat him here!"」

「"Defeat him and get the story!"」

「"You crazy guy. Die! I’m telling you to stop and die!"」

Historical-grade Constellations were shouting urgently on the pale screen.

Every time the sword’s trajectory moved, someone's head was taken away.

「"That’s not enough to kill me, you bastards."」

「"Kaaaaaaak!"」

Historical-grade Constellations that receive a terrible blow and exit every time their incarnation bodies fall.

The 'Demon King of Salvation', who had defeated another Constellation, looked up at the sky covered in blood.

As if he were aware of someone's gaze looking at him.

【I don’t think he’s tired of it either.】

Asmodeus took a sip of the diet cola next to him and let out a sigh.

When he took his eyes off the screen for a moment and looked around, he saw kkomas Kim Dokjas looking at the screen with absorbed expressions.

The little Kim Dokjas had different clothes, heights, and facial expressions.

When he first brought them in, they definitely looked the same, but as time went by, they changed a little.

A kid wearing a brimmed hat with 'SSS' written on it. A kid wearing a uniform from a martial arts novel. A kid recording something while wearing horn-rimmed glasses...

The kids, all with different tastes and favorite stories, were concentrating on the same story at this very moment.

Asmodeus muttered with a light bitter smile.

【Like you.】

An explosion sounded from the screen again. The sound of someone falling. Screams and screams. Asmodeus was a little amazed as he watched the rain of meteors fall.

【By the way, this is my first time seeing something like that done in the seventh scenario area. The Nebulae have really gone crazy. I don’t know if the follow-up will be done properly.】

Perhaps the Nebulae also know. Even though only historical-grade Constellations were being replaced, that level was almost catastrophic.

【Well, when did those idiots think before moving?】

The 'Giant Nebula', which will be the main theme of this event, will probably suffer a huge blow of at least ten percent.

Nevertheless, the Nebulae carried out this operation. Even while resisting the probability of that terrifying <Star Stream>.

「For the first Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation', is worth it.」

【I remember the day I first met him.】

Even before becoming the 'Demon King of Salvation', the 'Demon King of Salvation' was a bold personification.

He dared to touch the 'Dark Keeper', a member of the Demon King's family, and even used shallow trick to avoid Asmodeus's curse.

Even though Asmodeus saw the entire process, he turned a blind eye.

This is because it was very interesting that a mere incarnation who did not have a single story did such a thing.

[The story 'The One Who Watched the Demon King of Salvation' nods.]

For the first time in a while, Asmodeus recognized the story stirring inside him and shook his head.

Long-term relationships sometimes become tales. Even if it was a bad relationship.

[Some Constellations that share stories with you have noticed your presence.]

[Some Constellations are displeased with your presence.]

Asmodeus burst into laughter.

Just in case, he did it anyway.

It seems that the Constellations of 'that world line' who like Kim Dokja were still alive.

【There’s plenty of cola and popcorn, so why don’t you come here too?】

The stars did not answer.

They wouldn't dare intervene either.

Because all the Constellations from other world lines, including Asmodeus himself, are bound by special restrictions.

Then someone pulled his sleeve. When he turned around, a kkoma Kim Dokja was there.

A particularly small individual among kkomas Kim Dokja.

【Is there a problem?. Kkoma Kim Dokja.】

Kkoma Kim Dokja looked up at him with wide eyes. Then he looked at the screen once, then at Asmodeus, and again.

【Hmm?】

Asmodeus's brow twitched greatly.

【Are you really asking me to help him now?】

He nodded his head vigorously.

Asmodeus gave a somewhat stern look.

【Kkoma Kim Dokja. Have you forgotten who I am? I am 'Representative Kim Dokja'. I am their enemy.】

Kkoma Kim Dokja tilted his head as if he didn't understand Asmodeus's words.

Asmodeus did not reply any further. Nevertheless, those clear eyes were looking at Asmodeus.

What kind of being is Kim Dokja?

Although he had gathered quite a few of his fragments, Asmodeus still could not understand Kim Dokja.

Kkoma Kim Dokja's fingertips touched the back of Asmodeus's hand. Asmodeus, startled by the sudden warmth, shook his hand away and muttered as if it were bothersome.

【Sorry, I can't help him. Have you forgotten that the theater suffered a huge blow due to our hasty intervention?】

Even though he knew that the kkoma Kim Dokja would not understand what he was saying, Asmodeus continued his speech.

【At that time, some of the theater's functions were damaged, so aren't we unable to properly 'recover the fragments' now? Why would I support someone who ruined my theater—】

Asmodeus, who had been talking up to that point, closed his mouth. This is because the kkoma Kim Dokja did not look like he understood anything at all.

【Why am I talking about it when you can't understand what I'm saying?】

There was no justification or reason for that, but if Asmodeus wanted to, he could have saved the Demon King of Salvation.

The problem is that if that happens, the story becomes complicated.

[The Nebula Alliance is watching your intervention.]

A message that seems to have been waiting for him.

Due to the previous intervention, the Giant Nebulae also noticed his presence.

If he were to intervene in that scenario here, Asmodeus would have to suffer a significant amount of loss.

【Anyway, his story won't end easily even if I don't come forward.】

Kkoma Kim Dokja's small hand, which hesitated, grabbed Asmodeus's cold hand again.

Asmodeus, who was tired of even shaking it off, did not avoid the hand.

He just stared at the screen with bored eyes.

【The end of this world will be much crueler than he thinks.】

---

How many incarnations had he cut down? He even forgot the count.

The fallen incarnations were piled up one after another under the lightly bouncing white and blue lightning.

[Some Constellations cannot withstand the shock of probability and fall into sleep.]

As the Constellations that had taken a huge hit due to unreasonable intervention in lower-level scenarios exited one after another, the number of those attacking them gradually decreased.

[Your incarnation body has reached its limit.]

Every time he swung his sword, he could taste the fishy taste of blood in his mouth. He can't remember the last time he fought like this.

"I've thought about it a lot."

The Demon King of Salvation swung his sword, swung it, and swung it again.

"After all, it’s a shame to die here."

Looking at the decrease in the number of historical-grade Constellations entering, they are also tired.

At this rate, there won't be any historical-grade left who can touch the Youngest, at least for the time being.

"I haven’t been able to fully tell my Youngest who 'Kim Dokja' is yet."

"What are you talking about? Stop and die! Please!"

He cut down another incarnation of the charging historical-grade Constellations.

"I also want to read 'Ways of Survival'."

Every Kim Dokja loves stories. The same was true for the 'Demon King of Salvation'. More than any other Kim Dokja, he loved 'Ways of Survival'.

However, in his opinion, the Youngest was the best when it came to persistence in telling stories.

Kim Dokja just likes the 'story' itself.

Kim Dokja reads even the stories that all other Kim Dokja ignore. After reading all those stories, Kim Dokja now wants to write a new story.

[The tale 'Demon King of Salvation' continues its storytelling.]

[The 'Dark Keeper' communicates with your tale.]

"Could it be possible to use something like 'Ways of Survival'?"

[Some great fate is wishing for your death!]

This is already the second message of fate he has heard.

Once three messages are filled, the power of [Fate] becomes more powerful.

He’s sure the Nebulae guys will fill that number.

"But you."

An arrow flew and struck close to the heart. Blood poured out from the mouth of the Demon King of Salvation, who had stumbled greatly. Nevertheless, the Demon King of Salvation did not fall.

"If this continues, even if you catch me, you will all be doomed."

Forcing [Fate] on an incarnation and forcing [Fate] on a Narrative-grade Constellation have different levels of probability.

However, the Giant Nebula did not correct the error of [Fate].

In other words, in order to force this [Fate], the Giant Nebula would have sacrificed a huge amount of probability.

"Forcing [Fate] does not end. At least the minimum probability of executing that [Fate] must be secured."

Even though he was stumbling, the Demon King of Salvation kept walking forward. One of the incarnations that was rushing towards him collapsed again.

"It means that you are far from being enough. Even our Youngest knows that."

The blood-stained Demon King of Salvation grinned. Incarnations were scattered everywhere he walked. Without collapsing, he cut down the historical-grade Constellations again and again.

"Damn you, you crazy person. You are crazy!"

"How could it be like that—"

No one could stop him from swinging his sword with arrows stuck all over his body.

They knew that if they pushed a little further he would collapse, but no one dared deal him the final blow.

"How could such a monster—"

It was a fight with a decided outcome.

The probability of a Giant Nebula supported them, and the greatest incarnations of historical-grade flocked to them.

Although it was not the power of their true bodies, the incarnation bodies with increased synchronization were dropped, and dropped, and dropped again.

And yet.

"Why?"

The 'Demon King of Salvation' did not fall.

The 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' muttered as if he were lost.

"Why don’t you fall down?"

He began to grow shy, afraid that he might not be able to kill him. As his head became stained with fear, the tales surrounding him began to come into view little by little.

[The tale 'Demon King of Salvation' continues its storytelling.]

Why do the 'Mythical Constellations' covet the 'Demon King of Salvation'?

Why did they want a piece of him so much, even though they called him a 'discarded god'?

The 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' foolishly thought that he would finally understand everything.

"Everyone—"

He couldn't bear to say anything.

Even though he knows he just needs to push a little harder, he’s not sure.

「I don’t think I can possibly kill that Constellation.」

[The Constellation 'Gatekeeper of Thebes' is persuaded by the story.]

This was the power of stories.

The reason why a historical-grade Constellation cannot defeat a Mythical-grade Constellation.

The great Constellations whose fighting spirit was broken began to hesitate and retreat.

But not all Constellations were convinced.

"As expected, it seems like historical-grade idiots weren’t enough."

A long spear flew from somewhere and pierced the back of the Demon King of Salvation.

One knee of the staggering 'Demon King of Salvation' broke for the first time.

He is not intimidated by such a powerful tale.

Likewise, only stars with great stories could do this.

[The aftereffects of probability begin to blow.]

A tailwind of probability that creeps in despite the rules of the 'scale'.

Clearly, this was proof that this scenario did not allow the existence of that 'Constellation'.

[The Constellation 'God of War' increases the synchronization rate with his incarnation!]

Ares, the God of War.

As many as 12 God Constellations of <Olympus> entered the war with their own incarnations.

[The Constellation 'God of War’ announces the end.]

The historical-grade Constellations that had been intimidated by Ares's orders rushed forward again.

The Demon King of Salvation grinned.

"Youngest, are you watching?"

The lightning striking from the sky became even stronger. Perhaps the Giant Nebula is sacrificing enormous probability for this transfer.

"You have to see a lot to write well."

Cutting down the Constellations that rush at him with one knee bent.

「White Blue lightning, which had not been supplied with sufficient magical power, blinked. The Demon King of Salvation actually took advantage of the imbalance in

magical power to cut down the incarnations as if performing acrobatics.」

Every time the 'Blade of Faith' flashed intermittently, a historical-grade's incarnation fell.

[The influence of the story 'Demon King of Salvation' is gradually decreasing.]

The ground in the area was set on fire by the heat wave wrapped in Ares's spear.

The Demon King of Salvation changed the mimicry form of 'Broken Faith' to 'Unbreakable Faith'.

He held his sword on the floor and took a deep breath.

A sentence for him was written above the [Fourth Wall].

「The Demon King of Salvation had people he wanted to see.」

When he lowered his head, he saw a cigarette on the floor. A lit cigarette smoking white smoke.

「He won’t be able to see them anymore.」

Smelling the acrid scent, the Demon King of Salvation read the sentence written on the wall.

A story narrating his death.

In the end, it was a sentence for Kim Dokja who wanted to read the story as well.

「Kim Dokja decided to accept the story.」

The Demon King of Salvation did not know who was writing the sentences on the wall.

It's like when he can't confirm whether the person behind that curtain is Yoo Joonghyuk or not.

However, some people write, some read, and some live.

Together, they will complete this story, forever unable to touch each other.

The Demon King of Salvation picked up the fallen cigarette and took a drag. Then, exactly one sip of the story seeped deep into his soul.

The Demon King of Salvation said while looking down at his cigarette.

"Keep writing, Han Sooyoung."

Seeing Ares approaching, the Demon King of Salvation mustered his last strength and held on to 'Unbreakable Faith.'

"Because I can still read more."

He was still curious about the end of this story.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 716 Episode 26 Star Ladder (12)

Cigarette smoke scattered in the air.

From a distance, the God of War Ares frowned and spoke.

"Are you taking the demons' favors? You are an unholy bastard."

"I don't smoke either. But…"

Memories slowly came back along with the cigarette dropping.

"There was someone who really liked this."

['Kim Dokja Fragment' responds to your emotions.]

With the memories slowly seeping in, the Demon King of Salvation recalled an old face. The girl who especially loved smoking.

'Kim Dokja', who used the rest of his life to save one person—

「The Demon King of Salvation looked down at his incarnation body that was slowly breaking apart.」

Did Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd round feel this way?

Did she endure this feeling every time she used [Avatar]?

"Youngest."

It wasn't his job to remember someone. The Second one does it much better.

But since meeting the Youngest, old memories have often come flooding back to him. He was filled with old tales, as if asking people not to forget him.

[Old tales begin to tell you a story.]

The Demon King of Salvation slowly looked back, as if looking back at his own life. The history he lived in was torn apart and it was difficult to find the proper path to it.

However, this place had its own history.

In the distance, Anna Croft and Christina Page were talking toward the sky with Cheon Inho on their back.

It seemed like they were negotiating a 'Star Ladder' with someone.

[Fragment of the story 'The Right Arm of a Poor Sword Master' reacts to you.]

His right arm felt like it was twitching, and a faint fragment of a story came to him.

'The Right Arm of a Poor Sword Master Who Was Stabbed in the Back by a Colleague'.

The Demon King of Salvation remembered fragments of the story. When he first obtained the fragment of the story, his incarnation body was in tatters, just like it is now.

[Fragment of the story 'The Right Arm of a Poor Sword Master' feels your longing.]

Yes, you remember too.

"The sword master’s tale? You have a trash story."

Ares's brows furrowed slightly as he watched the Demon King of Salvation from afar.

"You haven’t been able to subdue that guy yet, Gatekeeper of Thebes."

"We’ll kill you right now! Everyone charge!"

The historical-grade Constellations, energized by the command of the Narrative-grade Constellations, shouted and rushed in once again.

The Demon King of Salvation dodged the incoming attack with minimal movement. Every time he shook his head or turned around, a bloody trail passed over his body.

[Your incarnation body will disappear after 5 minutes.]

The 'Dark Keeper's' body began to tremble as if he was nervous.

The Demon King of Salvation spoke as if to reassure him.

"Don't worry. I can kill them all."

"I still think this makes no sense—"

[The story fragment 'The Right Arm of a Poor Sword Master' begins its storytelling.]

This story fragment was a story that the Demon King of Salvation discovered in the 'Scenario Horizon'.

A tale that was abandoned because no one wrote it.

Waste excluded from the scenario.

Ares was looking 30 steps ahead.

"It's just this story—!"

The incarnation of the great Constellation that shouted like that was split in half. The astonished incarnations of historical-grade screamed.

Sword Master.

The incarnations of the historical-grade Constellations were collapsing helplessly due to the 'mass-produced stories' that the Constellations ignored.

One step at a time. The number of corpses increased at every corner of the path that the Demon King of Salvation walked.

「There are no useless stories.」

No matter how much the Constellations have increased their synchronization rate, this scenario is ultimately the 'seventh scenario'.

The Constellations were unable to fully reveal their status, and they were not familiar with the fighting methods of the lower-level scenarios they had graduated from a long time ago.

In the end, lower level scenarios are advantageous to those who are better at using 'lower grade' stories.

And the Demon King of Salvation,

[The story 'The One Who is Loved by All Things' continues its storytelling.]

He was the Constellation that could do that job best in this world.

"Kill him! Kill him!"

Twenty steps.

"Please, please stop him!"

Ten steps.

"Kaaaaaaak!"

The Demon King of Salvation was just around the corner.

Ares's expression suddenly hardened.

"Bouncer!"

As the story of Ares began to unfold, the Demon King of Salvation could no longer move forward.

In an instant, a fierce battle ensued.

[Fragment of the story 'The Right Arm of a Poor Sword Master Who Was Stabbed in the Back by a Colleague' fulfills his calling.]

The fragments of the story could not withstand the pressure and broke apart. For a moment, his body lost its balance and tilted. Ares's spear tore through the air.

Blood dripped down.

The right arm of the Demon King of Salvation rolled on the floor.

"It's all over. Fragment of a discarded god."

The moment Ares was about to deliver the final blow to the one-armed Demon King of Salvation.

"Ares."

The Demon King of Salvation said.

"I’m so glad you came here."

"What?"

"Do you know why?"

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

"I’ve already killed you before."

[The story 'The One Who Defeated the God of War' begins its storytelling.]

As the tales flowing from the Demon King of Salvation began to encroach on the surroundings, Ares's pupils widened.

"How dare you—"

The story of the defeat of the 'God of War' in the 3rd round. However, in order to unleash the power of this story, a condition was needed.

「"Kim Dokja, you only get one chance."」

Yoo Joonghyuk in the 3rd round.

And the 'long spear of Hercules' that will defeat him.

「"For me, it was always just once."」

However, compared to the 3rd round, Yoo Joonghyuk is beyond the curtain, and the spear they threw together back then is not here.

Props to recreate the stage do not exist here.

"Back then, we killed you with a 'fake story'."

But here, however clumsily, there was an item that could satisfy both at the same time.

"I really wonder what it will be like this time."

['Thoughts of Almost Everything' respond to your will!]

A pre-saved image appeared in his thoughts along with a bright beam of light.

['Thoughts of Almost Everything' mimics 'Weolgeuk'.]

Weolgeuk.

In the 41st round, 'Yoo Joonghyuk's 'spear' was in his hand.

The Demon King of Salvation also knew this spear well.

One of Yoo Joonghyuk's favorite weapons along with 'Jincheon Paedo' and 'Heukcheon Mado'.

Someday, this window will be completed as 'Amcheonwolgeuk'.

"You—!"

Unfortunately, he won't be able to see that scene.

Coo coo coo coo!

Ares, who had raised his level, and the Demon King of Salvation clashed. As the story of the formidable <Olympus> became entangled with Ares's spear, the battle became a high pitched battle.

In an instant, Ares's thigh burst open, piercing the side of the Demon King of Salvation. Every time attacks were exchanged, the two incarnations bodies were brutally destroyed.

"I will definitely kill you—!"

As if he couldn't accept the story of how he was murdered, Ares unleashed a storm of blows.

Now it was time for the finale of the story.

[The exclusive skill 'Bookmark' is activated!]

The Demon King of Salvation thought of an incarnation who was better at using weapons than anyone else in this world.

"I am."

But he couldn't continue talking.

Tsutsutsu!

Wild sparks flew out as if even the scale would not allow that probability.

Perhaps after using this [Bookmark], he will no longer have any possibility of existing.

Still, he had to complete this story.

"Han Sooyoung."

At some point, the sentences written on the [Fourth Wall] for him were cut off.

The Demon King of Salvation instinctively knew.

「Han Sooyoung will not be able to write the next sentence.」

There is no way that the one who started the story to save Kim Dokja could write a story that kills Kim Dokja.

However, there was one more writer in this world line.

"Youngest."

「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint is now active. The Youngest, who fainted, would also be looking at this scene.」

"You have to do it."

Ares's enraged voice was getting faster and faster. Every time the spear's blade was struck, the new form of the Demon King of Salvation stumbled dangerously.

"Just one line."

Finally, as if preparing for the final blow, the incarnation body of Ares erupted into pitch-black flames.

The moment when the entire story exploded to burn down the entire area.

"I am."

The Demon King of Salvation said.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Lightning struck and the world became bright.

The incarnations of the area stared at the battlefield with their eyes wide open.

The two weapons flew towards each other, and the sound of something being roughly torn apart was heard.

And after a while.

"Ugh, uhm, uwwaaaaa!"

Gatekeeper of Thebes screamed in fear.

The incarnation of Ares, whose entire lower body had been blown away, was writhing on the floor.

[The Constellation 'God of War' has suffered enormous damage!]

[The Constellation 'Gad of War' writhes in pain!]

Across from him, the Demon King of Salvation, who had lost both legs, was breathing heavily.

['Bookmark' is released.]

[Your incarnation has suffered non-regenerative damage.]

The dying incarnation of Ares looked up at him.

"Demon King of Salvation. I will admit it. You are really strong."

The next moment, Ares's incarnation body was engulfed in a pitch black air current.

"Enough to be worth sacrificing our greatest."

The incarnation body engulfed in demonic energy was regenerating Ares's severed lower body.

[The Nebula <Olympus> sacrifices their giant story.]

A feat that sacrificed Olympus’s 'giant story'.

The revived Ares roared into the air.

Even in the face of his death, the Demon King of Salvation had a calm expression.

Now, <Olympus> and <Asgard> will not be able to intervene in the scenario in any way for the time being. If they go against probability even further, the 'Outer Gods' they fear will come.

The Youngest will be able to continue his own story.

[Your incarnation body will soon disappear.]

[Some great fate is wishing for your death.]

The third fateful message finally fell. The end that not even the stars can resist had come.

[The 'Dark Keeper' closes his eyes, satisfied with the story he shared with you.]

Thank you. I will go soon too.

[A new story has been born in the <Star Stream>!]

One character exits and the story comes to an end.

Through his darkening vision, the Demon King of Salvation recalled the story he loved.

When he thought about it, there was one last scene I wanted to read.

"For Dokja, a dokja’s (reader) life."

And, for the Demon King of Salvation...

He didn't even have the strength left to open his mouth anymore.

The Demon King of Salvation closed his eyes as he watched the flying weapon.

As always, death was something he was familiar with.

But this time, even after this, he didn't feel any pain.

Is he already dead? But has there ever been a painless death like this?

Did his incarnation disappear and even the sense of pain disappeared?

At that time, a breeze blew from somewhere.

A nostalgic scent followed.

The sound of the old subway lingered in his ears like an auditory hallucination.

The Demon King of Salvation slowly opened his eyes.

"I missed one."

A faintly fluttering silhouette.

The story on the wall was speaking.

「The Demon King of Salvation knows that this story is impossible.」

Nevertheless, the story became reality and picked him up as he fell.

「If you think about it, his life began in reality, not in a novel.」

As if whispering the origin of a memory he had long since forgotten.

"For Sangah, an sangah's (ivory) life."

The Demon King of Salvation smiled faintly.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 717 Episode 26 Star Ladder (13)

Bullets flew from somewhere and rained down on his head. The cargo's surprise commission accomplishments evacuated the incarnation.

"What kind of guy—!"

At the same time, shells more than twice the amount of charge poured out. It was not ordinary bullets.

Each magical bullet was filled with concentrated magical energy.

As several incarnations fell after being attacked, the enraged Constellations looked in the direction where the fire started.

"Those scum-like incarnations—"

The incarnations dressed as refugees continued shooting.

"Keep shooting."

There was a man standing in the center of the refugees.

Jacob Martinez.

Las Vegas’s 'King of the North'.

The historical-grade Constellations, running at remarkable speed, quickly broke through the ranks of refugees and rushed at Martinez.

The moment Martinez opened his eyes, the historical-grade Constellations in each direction cut off Martinez's arms and torso.

"Hahaha! You idiot!"

The severed limbs along with the blood flowed through the air.

[The character 'Jacob Martinez' activates 'Cutting Magic Lv.7'!]

Martinez, who quickly put the cut off limbs back together, looked toward the back and spoke.

"We can’t take too long. The opponent is <Olympus>."

"I know."

"Go. With this, the North has paid its debt."

The woman nodded her head and hugged the fallen Demon King of Salvation. Her body trembled as he entered the process of extinction.

"Don’t move."

The Demon King of Salvation looked up at the woman. An off-white color that shines brightly even on the battlefield.

It wasn't the face he remembered.

"I thought it was Yoo Sangah."

Ji Eunyu laughed heartily.

"I am her incarnation."

The incarnation of Yoo Sangah. Maybe that's why the atmosphere strangely resembles Yoo Sangah.

"It’s dangerous out here. If you’re here to save the Youngest, you’re in the wrong place. The Youngest is over there—"

"They’re still negotiating with the 'Recycling Center'."

Are the negotiations still not over?

Then the situation was not good.

A situation where <Olympus> resurrected Ares by burning a giant tale. If he doesn’t send the Youngest up quickly—

"Is that all you have to say?"

Ji Eunyu said as she ran while holding the Demon King of Salvation in her arms.

"There’s something I need to say first."

An incarnation that resembles Yoo Sangah not only in her mood but also in her tone of voice.

Ji Eunyu continued her words with a light sigh.

"I was asked to keep an eye on you because you might still do something like this."

"..."

"She wanted to use the Golden Headband, but she also asked me to tell you that it’s a pity that she couldn’t do that."

Golden Headband.

The Demon King of Salvation opened his mouth without realizing it.

"I am not the Kim Dokja that Yoo Sangah is looking for."

As he said those words, the Demon King of Salvation thought of the Third child. The Third had the main memory related to the 'Headband'.

"As if that person isn’t Yoo Sangah."

In the rapidly rushing scenery, the Demon King of Salvation felt his stories dispersing.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' continues with a stutter.]

Ji Eunyu's hand wrapped around him and held on to the scattered stories.

"You are the Kim Dokja she is looking for."

It was a very warm hand.

"I've read more stories about you than anyone else, so I guarantee you."

Is it because the woman telling that story really looked like Yoo Sangah?

The Demon King of Salvation slowly opened his mouth.

"How is Yoo Sangah?"

"Are you okay?"

"Tell her I'm sorry."

"Please tell her directly."

"You say you are the incarnation of Yoo Sangah."

"You heard I'm not Yoo Sangah."

"For now, let's assume you're Yoo Sangah. So—"

The Demon King of Salvation knew.

Yoo Sangah cannot come here.

He doesn't know if it's because of the 'scale of probability' or the restrictions of the 'Void Curtain', but at least she won't be able to come until he dies.

Perhaps his words will not be conveyed properly to Yoo Sangah.

"Thank you so much, Yoo Sangah."

But at least it will remain as a story.

And one day, Yoo Sangah will read his story left on this wall.

The Demon King of Salvation was satisfied with that.

"Really, thank you."

His scenario is now over.

Now the protagonist and characters of this story have changed.

"I don’t know what you’re thankful for."

Nonetheless, the story continues.

"I’m going to ask, so make sure you’re alive until then."

Is it because there is still a story left unfinished?

The Demon King of Salvation slowly blinked his eyes and asked.

"Is that what Yoo Sangah just said?"

"That’s just what I said?"

"You are just the incarnation of Yoo Sangah."

"I just decided to be Yoo Sangah."

Ji Eunyu said, kicking the ground with all her might and running.

"I don’t know, but Yoo Sangah would definitely have said that."

The explosion sound coming from behind was gradually fading away.

The northern king's troops were annihilated.

"I heard about you from my Youngest."

Editor Ji Eunyu.

In his Youngest's memory, she was quite an important figure.

She was the first to read and edit the stories the Youngest wrote. Perhaps, without her, his 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' written by his Youngest would not have been possible.

「"Writer, look. Kim Dokja’s lines here are a bit strange."」

"I think this line suits him."

"No! Look, he wasn’t a character who spoke like this before—"

"Isn’t that the character’s three-dimensionality?"

"This is not three-dimensional, it’s a kabung."」

A thought suddenly occurred to him.

If he and Yoo Sangah had been reincarnated in a different world, wouldn't they have been like that?

「Doesn’t Kim Dokja want to be someone else sometimes?」

A world without scenarios and Constellations. A world where all these tragedies are just imagination in the lines of text.

The Youngest came from that world.

"You stayed here to save the Youngest?"

Ji Eunyu did not answer.

"You’re like the Youngest Yoo Sangah."

"I’m not Yoo Sangah. Stop talking. The story will be scattered."

"I’m going to die anyway. There’s less than a minute left."

Ji Eunyu’s steps stopped.

The historical-grade Constellations hidden in the front line appeared one by one. Additional historical-grade Constellations dispatched from <Olympus> appeared accompanied by their incarnations.

"Turn off [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint] and run away! That’s it."

"No. I’ve put restrictions on it."

It is different from the general [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

The Demon King of Salvation risked his own life to kill the incarnations of historical-grade and kill the incarnation of Ares, a Narrative-grade Constellation.

"This [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint] cannot be canceled on its own."

In other words, when this incarnation body disappears, he also disappears.

"What on earth were you thinking? You're the one they're after."

"I know."

"Then why—"

Why did he do such an unreasonable thing?

The Demon King of Salvation doesn't know much either.

He may have believed that his stage was not over yet.

He may have wanted to recreate the days when he was hunting down Constellations as the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

When he saw the story of the Youngest fighting desperately alone, his blood boiled without him knowing, and he may have wanted to prove that he, too, was a 'Kim Dokja'.

The 'Thought' borrowed from the Youngest hummed and cried.

"The Demon King of Salvation I know never dies."

"..."

"You know that he is a person who survives no matter what he does, right?"

Historical-grade Constellations approached from all directions.

There was no place to run now.

There was no way for them to escape unless the 'Star Ladder' came down.

But what star would dare to lower the 'Star Ladder' against the 'Giant Nebula'?

"So please save him."

As Ji Eunyu said those words, her gaze rested on Cheon Inho in the distance for a moment.

"Please, save Kim Dokja."

The Demon King of Salvation listened to those words blankly. Perhaps he came all the way here because he wanted to hear those words.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' wants to continue its storytelling.]

The Demon King of Salvation, who stumbled out of Ji Eunyu's arms, spoke.

"Okay."

Beyond the incarnations of historical-grade Constellations that surrounded them, a man with a fearsome appearance was walking.

"Demon—King—of—Salvation"

It was the resurrected incarnation of Ares.

Tsutsutsu!

Ares walked forward, enduring aftereffects that exceeded the probability limit.

Even if all his remaining stories were exploded, it was impossible to defeat him.

Thunder struck once again across the night sky. The Demon King of Salvation thought of Yoo Joonghyuk.

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk or Kim Dokja Company will not be able to come. Because the Giant Nebulae will be blocking them by sacrificing their giant stories.

Not only them, but no one else in this world can intervene in this scenario where the Giant Nebulae run rampant.

「Except for only one place.」

The Demon King of Salvation raised his head.

"Are you there?"

They are the group that controls this 'world' itself.

Those who control the scenario in the torrent of the <Star Stream> and guide the world to the ■■ of everything.

"Bihyung."

Sparks struck in the air at the call of the Demon King of Salvation. And,

—Are you serious?

Bihyung, a Dokkaebi belonging to the 'Management Bureau' responded.

"Yes."

The Demon King of Salvation knew. Bihyung is probably not the only one listening to him now.

The Great Dokkaebis of this world line— even perhaps the Dokkaebi King beyond—are also listening to his story.

And what he's going to say, he's already guessing.

—The price will be very high.

He knows. Perhaps it would be more cruel than death.

"It does not matter."

Nevertheless, he has to meet his Youngest again.

When they meet, he has to tell him what he hasn't told him yet.

What kind of person is the 'real Kim Dokja'?

Where is Han Sooyoung, whom he was searching for?

How can readers from other world lines be sent back?

Who is the guy who killed us?

And—

「Why does this 'world' exist?」

The Constellations noticed something unusual and rushed towards this direction.

"That bastard! Stop him—!"

Looking at them, the Demon King of Salvation grinned.

「You will get nothing.」

The Demon King of Salvation declared.

"I will dedicate myself to the <Star Stream>."

Then the world responded to his words.

[The <Star Stream> accepts your offer.]

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' is consecrated to the 'Star Stream'.]

"Stop! You bastard!"

The fact that the Constellation sealed itself in the 'Star Stream' was tantamount to voluntarily becoming the subject of a scenario.

[The mayor of 'Jeonsang City' wants to incorporate the 'Demon King of Salvation' into his scenario.]

[The host of 'Ragnarok' wants to incorporate the 'Demon King of Salvation' into his scenario.]

[The 'Fallen ruins' owner wants to incorporate the 'Demon King of Salvation' into his scenario.]

[The creator of the 'Holy Demon War' wants to incorporate the 'Demon King of Salvation' into his scenario.]

…

[The director of the 'Recycling Center' wants to incorporate the 'Demon King of Salvation' into his scenario.]

He didn't know how he would be used in which scenario. But now he had offered himself and was entitled to ask for it in return.

"I accept the granting authority of the 'Star Ladder'."

[The 'Management Bureau' approves your payment.]

Ares arrived right in front of the Demon King of Salvation and swung his spear.

In a split second, a dazzling beam of light appeared and the incarnation of the 'Demon King of Salvation' disappeared.

"No!"

At the same time, a bright ladder began to come down from thin air.

「Star Ladder.」

An opportunity to ascend to heaven given to several incarnations in exchange for the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Anna Croft and Selena Kim climbed the ladder to help Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk, who had fallen, and Ji Eunyu also held onto the ladder with Martinez.

The ladder carrying all the scheduled incarnations began to ascend to the sky.

Coo coo coo coo!

Ares was furious and went berserk.

"I can’t admit it!"

Ares's angry body stretched out his hand toward the Star Ladder.

"Stop it! Stop his incarnation from using the Star Ladder! Just make him drop it somehow!"

Historical-grade Constellations, including the Gatekeeper of Thebes, belatedly attacked the ladder.

However, a translucent curtain created sparks and blocked their intervention.

"How dare you—"

At that moment, Ares felt like the scales of the scenario were balanced.

It was impossible.

If there is a being who can achieve equilibrium with a Narrative-grade Constellation—

[Stop, Ares.]

All the Constellations, including Ares, stopped along with their incarnations at the mantra filled with tremendous power.

Ares lifted his head and looked up at the sky in disbelief.

At the end of the Star Ladder leading to the 'Recycling Center' were beings with pure white wings spread out.

Unlike <Olympus> and <Asgard>, which participated in the scenario, these stars were the only ones among the three Giant Nebulae that remained silent.

"Eden!"

[The Constellation 'Lilies Blooming on Water Ice' reveals themselves!]

A line of Constellations was blocking the road leading to the Recycling Center.

[The scenario is over. Without further compromising probability, go back to your own context.]

"How dare you, how dare you—"

Ares couldn't understand. Why is <Eden> involved in this situation?

Especially at this timing.

Ares bit his lip and revealed his fierceness to the being standing beyond the Archangels.

"Center Director! I know you’re hiding there!"

There is no need to fight <Eden>.

After all, the 'Star Ladder' is not under the jurisdiction of <Eden>.

"Cancel the Star Ladder! The 'Demon King of Salvation' is ours!"

[No. Now he belongs to the '<Star Stream>'.]

With a hollow laugh, the Center Director's voice was heard from the Archangel's shadow.

[<Olympus>. Have you forgotten the Nebula Agreement? You cannot interfere with the 'Recycling Center' scenario.]

"Asgard has declared [Fate]. Three [Fate] messages have been sent to him! He cannot avoid them! He—"

[The Fate that came down to him was to 'die in a loved story'.]

When all the incarnations completed their ascension, the 'Star Ladder' began to disperse. The portal to the Recycling Center was closing little by little.

The Center Director, with a strange smile, left his last words while looking at the ruined Washington Dome.

[I guess that story isn't here.]

"Wait! Wait! You guys—"

['Star Ladder' has disappeared.]

[All scenarios in the 'Washington Dome' area end.]

[The scales of the scenario are tipped.]

[The balance of probability is lost.]

Ares and the historical-grade Constellations that were left behind hurriedly looked at each other.

Unusual sparks were raging throughout Washington.

"Everyone withdraw—"

[A potential storm begins to blow!]

The aftermath that followed erased everything in Washington.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 718 Episode 27 Recycling Center (1)

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「I wanted to show it to the world. Even ordinary stories can become great stories.」

---

I heard a tinnitus buzzing in my ears. I felt dizzy, as if someone was shaking my skull.

「"Youngest."」

Words flowing through my head.

What followed were scenes that came to mind.

The Demon Marquis of the Capitol. The Demon King of Salvation who possessed him. Great Constellations rushing towards him. Ares, the 12th god of Olympus, came to kill the Demon King of Salvation.

「"You have to do it."」

The sense of the sentences I had unconsciously written in the blurry atmosphere was vivid at my fingertips.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."」

[The Constellations of the Giant Nebula are astonished by your achievements!]

Twisted probability.

The Demon King of Salvation rushing towards Ares.

[Some small and medium-sized Nebulae are depressed by your presence.]

[Some Constellations in the little Nebulae are starting to cheer for your presence.]

[The Constellations of the Korean Peninsula are worried about your future.]

The fate message.

Ares was resurrected.

[The Constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' is proud of you.]

[The Constellation 'White Shark' is full of admiration for your achievements.]

Giant Nebula. Falling meteors.

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is worried for your safety.]

[The Constellation 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' nods to your courage.]

Ji Eunyu.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' curses at the cowardly Giant Nebula…]

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'… ]

And.

[Your new story has been born.]

[The new story will be shared with your sponsor.]

I muttered absentmindedly.

"Kim Dokja."

I looked around.

"Kim Dokja."

No one answered.

"Demon King of Salvation!"

Even though I screamed at the top of my lungs, my voice was weak and muffled. A cold feeling touched my cheek.

It was snowing.

Pure white snowy field. Footprints of someone walking ahead.

I walked along those footprints. At first I walked, but soon I started running.

I ran, suppressing my rising breath. On the way, I fell a few times and ended up in the snow. My feet suddenly fell into the cold, with sore eyes.

「"I will offer myself to <Star Stream>."」

A strange sound, neither a scream nor a regular sound, came from inside me.

That can't be possible. There's no way he's dead.

There is no way that Kim Dokja, that Demon King of Salvation, would disappear like this.

How long did I run like that?

Finally I reached the end of the footprints.

A shaking white coat.

There stood the person I was desperately looking for.

I staggered towards him. The moment I slowly stretched out my hand and touched his shoulder, Kim Dokja looked back.

「Huh.」

I looked blankly at his face. Clearly, he had the face of the 'Kim Dokja' I knew. The calm eyes and neatly smiling lips were clearly Kim Dokja's.

But he.

「He was not the 'Demon King of Salvation' I knew.」

Only then did I slowly come to my senses.

I realized where this place was.

I have entered the snowy field.

"You—"

And the 'Kim Dokja' in front of me now was the 'Kim Dokja of the Snowy Field' that I had met for the first time.

Kim Dokja feels sometimes sad, sometimes incomprehensible, and at the same time distant.

I asked him.

"Where is the Demon King of Salvation?"

As usual, Kim Dokja took out a teacup from his chest, lazily poured his tea and took a sip.

Steam rose from the teacup, and Kim Dokja slowly looked up at the sky, following the dispersing water vapor.

A falling meteor shower decorated the empty sky of the snowy field. Perhaps it is the Historical-grade Constellations of the 'Giant Nebulae' that were sacrificed in this fight.

「It was a really interesting story.」

Interesting story.

「It’s been a long time since I’ve seen the Giant Nebulae get into trouble like that.」

His enjoyment was not unusual. Because he is Kim Dokja, who loves stories more than anyone else in this universe.

Normally I might have talked about him and the Constellations for hours.

"Kim Dokja. Where is the Demon King of Salvation?"

But I didn't feel like it right now.

"You saw it too. Everyone was watching it."

A cold flame boiled inside me. A feeling that I didn't have before.

The snow on the ground was melting around me.

Kim Dokja looked down at my feet and asked.

「Do you remember what I said before?」

What he said.

「I told you to say whatever you want.」

Right.

「Is that really what you wanted to talk about?」

"What is that—"

「Why did you sign a contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation'?」

Kim Dokja was looking at the sky, so I couldn't see his expression.

But I could tell just by the way he spoke.

Now he was angry.

「I thought you would make a wise choice.」

Why is he angry?

「You shouldn’t be a 'Kim Dokja' like them.」

Kim Dokja’s words sounded very strange to me.

Until now, I thought he would support me no matter what I said.

But actually, did he also have a story that he wanted to see through me?

I don't know. Honestly, I didn't have time to think about such things right now.

"Kim Dokja. I’ll say it again. I want to save the Demon King of Salvation. Please tell me how to save the Demon King of Salvation."

「I can’t help you.」

"Why?"

「Because he and I pursue different ■ ■.」

"What are you talking about? You and him are both Kim Dokja. You—"

At that moment, a strange question occurred to me.

The Demon King of Salvation once said something like that to me. It is said that 'Kim Dokja' in this world line was divided into several large chunks centered on modifiers.

"The Demon King of Salvation said he was the First Kim Dokja."

So then, who is the Kim Dokja in front of me right now? How many 'Kim Dokjas' is this?

"What number are you?"

The Demon King of Salvation called me the 'Youngest'. In that case, Kim Dokja in front of me would be a brother before me.

Second or Third?

"Kim Dokja?"

But strangely enough, as I looked at him, it seemed like he was neither of those things.

Who is Kim Dokja?

He is,

「You.」

Was this really the 'Kim Dokja' I knew?

「You shouldn't be Kim Dokja's 'Youngest'.」

"That's up to me to decide. If I really am the reincarnation of Kim Dokja—"

Even as I said this, I was surprised.

Because I never thought I would say those words out of my mouth.

Is this the influence of the Demon King of Salvation?

Do I really think of myself as 'Kim Dokja' now?

「Hakhyun-ah.」

Kim Dokja sighed lightly and extended his hand towards me. But at that moment, I instinctively felt wary. I felt like I shouldn't touch his hand.

As I was staggering back, thunder struck again in the distance.

But Kim Dokja's hands were fast, and I couldn't avoid it.

Tsutsutsu.

It was then that sparks flew in the air. My hand moved of its own accord and grabbed Kim Dokja’s wrist.

Then an unfamiliar voice came out of my mouth.

"I’m disappointed. Are you trying to break the rules?"

Then Kim Dokja, whose expression hardened, spoke.

"Don’t disturb. Cheon—"

Thunder struck again and the snowy landscape was torn apart.

---

When I came to my senses, I was lying face down on the unfamiliar dirt floor, nauseating.

It felt like someone had disassembled my body into joints and reassembled it.

It was natural.

「Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint was maintained for a long time, and 'Goryeo’s First Sword' was summoned using Bookmark and even used the Three-Sword Style. If the scale of probability had not prevented the aftermath, it would not be surprising if my body had been torn apart long ago. Surviving itself was a miracle.」

After taking a few breaths, I opened my mouth as if squeezing my throat.

"Is there anyone?"

No one answered.

[Transmission via 'Star Ladder' has been completed.]

[A new main scenario will begin soon.]

Even while I was unconscious from [Daily Invoice], I checked the situation on the battlefield through [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

Clearly, Anna Croft and Christina used the 'Star Ladder' with Yoo Joonghyuk on their backs.

"Is there anyone?"

I suddenly felt alone.

[Main Scenario #7 —'Invasion of the Demon World' has ended.]

[Sub-scenario—'Beast Hunt' has ended.]

When I think about it, I have been alone ever since I entered this world.

And yet, once again, I realize that I am alone.

"Constellation-nim."

It may be because I remembered that I was not alone for a brief moment.

[A total of 600,000 coins were obtained as compensation.]

It felt like he was talking in my ear like usual.

The Youngest has earned so many coins. It seemed like he would be happy to finally be able to buy the 'Demon King's modifier'.

[You have been given the option to choose a 'Narrative-grade story'.]

That we did it together.

[Your achievements will be announced on the <Star Stream>.]

[The modifier 'Demon King of Salvation' is announced on the Star Stream.]

Those damn Giant Nebulae have finally been dealt a blow.

[In recognition of your amazing achievements, the 'Management Bureau' will improve and adjust the rewards of the sub-scenario.]

[You have been provided with an 'SS-grade skill selection'.]

Check out the newly received rewards and think together about what to choose.

I felt like he was going to make a fuss because this story was good and that skill was good.

"Constellation-nim."

There was no voice heard. Instead, faint sparks flew out in the air. An unprecedented feeling that faintly flows into me.

A sense of relief washed over me.

「The sponsorship contract has not been cut off.」

It was proof that he was still alive somewhere in this world.

"Why."

I wanted to ask.

"Why did you do that?"

Even though I knew it was meaningless to ask such a question to the 'Demon King of Salvation', I wanted to ask.

He offered himself to the <Star Stream> in exchange for saving me.

Just like Shin Yoosung in the 41st Round.

He had fought against the story his whole life, and ended up becoming part of it to save me.

"Why—"

Am I worth it?

"You, you are the real Kim Dokja."

If there is only one Kim Dokja left in this world, shouldn't it be you?

Tsutsutsut.

A sound was heard once again. It wasn't a probability spark. The sound was coming from inside my arms. The smartphone was vibrating.

Smartphone.

I reflexively took out my phone. It wasn't my phone.

It was Kim Dokja's.

The phone that Kim Dokja always had in his hand.

A screen appeared on the liquid crystal display. There was a file lying all over the empty desktop.

I looked at the file blankly and pressed the button without realizing it.

「There are three ways to survive in a ruined world.」

There was a star who loved this story more than anyone else.

A sentence he must have read countless times.

「I've forgotten a few things now. But one thing is certain.」

A sentence that would have saved him from death time and time again.

I also read that sentence.

「That is the fact that you, who are reading this now, will survive.」

This is what he left me.

I read that sentence over and over again.

And then I stood up and started walking.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 719 Episode 27 Recycling Center (2)

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The place I fell into was a dense forest area.

[Enter the eighth scenario area.]

[The will-o'-the-wisp guides you.]

The will-o'-the-wisp buzzed before me like a little firefly.

But I didn't move right away. Because I needed to know where this place was.

It's late at night. The forest with lush broadleaf trees covering the sky felt somewhat mountainous and scary.

There were no stars in the sky.

Even indirect messages were not heard.

I came up with a hypothesis in my head.

First, this is an area that the Constellations cannot yet see.

Second, the Constellations are not interested because the area I am in is outside the scenario.

Whatever the theory, it was best to avoid battle as much as possible in my current state.

The cries of animals were often heard.

I crouched as low as I could and went into the bushes holding my breath.

"Dokkaebi Bag."

Fortunately, the 'Dokkaebi Bag' worked normally.

I bought items needed for the homeless from the bag.

[You purchased the item 'Body Odor Removal Spray'.]

[You purchased the item 'Small Bed'.]

[You purchased the item 'Someone’s old blanket'.]

[A total of 800 coins were used.]

These were the things that the Demon King of Salvation once told me were 'great items for homeless people'.

After spraying the surrounding area, I set up a 'bed' and covered it with 'someone's old blanket'.

The blanket fluttered like ectoplasm and slowly seeped into the background. From the outside, there was no way to tell that there was a hiding place in the bushes.

[The hidden item combination has been completed.]

[The special option 'It’s dangerous outside the blanket' is activated.]

When I squeezed inside the transparent blanket, I could clearly see outside.

The downside is that the interior is so narrow that one adult male can barely lie down.

It didn't matter because I was the only one in the group anyway.

As I slowly curled up under the thick blanket, for some reason, a familiar memory came to mind.

「"If you look at books there, your eyes will get worse!"」

Memories of hiding under a blanket and reading a book with a small light on.

Is it my memory or Kim Dokja’s memory?

「"Is it okay?"」

Is it really that important to reveal the origins of anyone's memories?

「"You have to sleep not too late."」

I turned on the smartphone that Kim Dokja left behind and started reading 'Ways of Survival'.

---

One day passed, and then two days passed. My daily routine was simple.

[The will-o'-the-wisp guides you.]

When the sun rose, I followed the ghostly fire through the forest area, and at night, I took a nap in a blanket tent while reading 'Ways of survival'.

Sometimes I encountered monsters.

Grrrr—!

The monster species encountered are mainly 7th grade or 8th grade species.

After two days of camping, my body recovered quite a bit and I was able to fight against monsters.

The main thing I encountered was a huge wild boar.

[7th grade monster species 'Forest Wild Boar' has appeared.]

As I was trying to take out my weapon as usual, I suddenly realized that the Demon King of Salvation had borrowed my thoughts of almost everything.

Fortunately, there was one weapon left to replace it.

'Unbroken faith.'

Kim Dokja's main weapon, and the weapon left behind by the disappeared Han Sooyoung.

The bright blade of [Baekcheon-ganggi], which was now quite proficient, flashed.

「Youngest, how do you use [Baekcheon-ganggi]?」

I narrowly avoided the giant forest boar and refined my sword using the story 「Persistent Murin Master」.

The wild boar fell down in an instant, blood pouring from its side.

[The 7th grade monster species 'Forest Wild Boar' has been defeated.]

After collecting its core, I immediately started butchering it. Because I haven't eaten anything for two days already.

「You can never starve. If you don't have enough energy, your head won't work well. Yoo Joonghyuk eats eight meals a day.」

I looked for and read about the 'Forest Wild Boar's butchering' in 'Ways of Survival'.

The poisonous horns were removed, the skin was removed, the intestines were taken out, and the meat was sliced along the spine.

I gathered twigs and lit a fire.

There was no [Magic Brazier], but now it is possible to light a cooking flame without a brazier.

「Youngest, Yoo Joonghyuk, the best cook, what number of sessions did he say?」

For cooking wild boar, refer to Yoo Joonghyuk's recipe from the 81st Round. However, even though I followed Yoo Joonghyuk's recipe, the dish did not turn out well for some reason.

Probably because I am not Yoo Joonghyuk.

「Yoo Joonghyuk thought. 'Is it possible to achieve transcendence through cooking?'」

There are some obvious facts I learned while living alone.

For example, not all monster species are as delicious as 'Ground Puppy' or 'Yana Spreta'.

「Yoo Joonghyuk thought as he watched Kim Namwoon spitting up what he just ate. 'You can’t eat these ingredients by cooking them'.」

Monsters must be slaughtered three or four times a day, and emergency food must be stored in case the hunt fails.

「Yoo Joonghyuk thought as he looked at Kim Namwoon foaming at the mouth. 'If you eat this fruit, you will die within 1 minute'.」

Even in the apocalypse, you have to maintain hygiene and occasionally wash your body under running water.

「"Kim Namwoon, you smell bad."」

Then Lee Jihye held her nose and walked away.

「"Eww.…."」

If you don't have a place to wash, you can purchase [Clean Body] from the 'Dokkaebi Bag' and use it.

「Kim Namwoon used [Clean Body] right away.」

[Use the item 'Clean Body'.]

[50 coins were consumed.]

Three days, then four days passed.

It's been a long time since I've been alone like this.

Suddenly, memories of the day I first started living here came to mind.

「Kim Namwoon prayed. "Captain, can’t I eat first this time?"」

The fact is that humans need to eat something every day to survive.

「Yoo Joonghyuk gave the order. "No. From now on, you will be in charge of doing the laundry, Kim Namwoon!"」

The fact is that someone has to constantly run the washing machine in order to wear clean clothes.

「Yoo Joonghyuk gave the order. 'It’s your responsibility to clean up after monsters, Kim Namwoon."」

The fact is that if you don't clean up what you eat right away, bugs will be attracted.

「Yoo Joonghyuk gave the order. "And pay back 10,000 coins a day, Kim Namwoon."」

The fact is that you have to work and earn money to pay rent and resident tax.

By experiencing those extremely obvious facts firsthand, I managed to grow into a decent member of society.

「Yoo Joonghyuk gave the order, "Practice cutting 20,000 times a day!"」

Things that must be done to become an ordinary adult.

「Namwoon asked, "Damn it, how can I do all that!"」

Since when did Kim Dokja start doing things like that on his own?

「Yoo Joonghyuk answered, "I did it!"」

I often thought about Kim Dokja, who endured his childhood alone without the help of his parents—the Demon King of Salvation at a time when no one could yet save him.

A boy who worked to earn money, did laundry, cooked meals, washed dishes, occasionally paid rent, and read Ways of Survival before going to sleep.

「Yoo Joonghyuk answered, "You can do it too."」

Thinking of that boy, I also read 'Ways of Survival'.

And a week has passed.

Now monster hunting has become much more natural. The speed of butchering has also increased, and the skill proficiency has also increased.

I read 'Ways of Survival' repeatedly, looking for the information I needed.

I was able to properly distinguish between what was edible and what was not.

Whenever there was a stream, the water quality was checked and drinking water was stored.

I often washed my face with cold water. My face was reflected in the eerily clear stream.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' is looking at you blankly.]

For some reason, my face seemed to have changed a little. Is it an illusion?

[Collect the new 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.]

[Time remaining until death: 9 days 12:53]

"I guess I'll have to go get some new fragments soon."

['Recycling Center' responds to your self-talk.]

Recycling Center.

Over the past week, I've searched through the entire 'Ways of Survival' and found every bit of information about the eighth scenario.

['Recycling Center' senses the potential for a new 'main character' in you.]

Originally, the eighth scenario on the Korean Peninsula was 'Black Castle'.

New Demon World—A stage that exists to elect the 73rd Lord of the Demon World.

However, the eighth stage of the 41st Round was 'Recycling Center'.

「If 'Black Castle' is a stage for electing a new Demon King, then 'Recycling Center' is a stage for electing a new Constellation.」

An area that can only be reached through the 'Star Ladder'.

「Any incarnation that graduates from the 'Recycling Center' can definitely become a 'Constellation' regardless of their origin.」

According to the explanation of the 'Ways of Survival', it was possible to rise to the status of a Constellation with a sponsor by using the 'Recycling Center'.

If you look at it up to this point, it wasn't a bad scenario.

「But Yoo Joonghyuk almost never used the 'Recycling Center'.」

The problem is that the level of difficulty of this 'Recycling Center' is such that even Regressor Yoo Joonghyuk shakes his head.

It was understandable that the Demon King of Salvation was reluctant about this scenario.

But he eventually sent me here.

[Guide ends.]

[Arrived at the 'assembly point'.]

Finally, the wisp's guidance came to an end. I looked around.

The place we arrived was the entrance to somewhere. At the entrance stood an usher holding a small attendance board in her hand.

"Hmm."

It was a guide wearing a sheep-shaped mask.

"Is there anyone who hasn’t come in yet?"

The receptionist looked me up and down and spoke in a bored voice.

"It looks like you’re from the Frontier Nebula. Is that right?"

"I am not affiliated with any Nebula."

"Huh. Oh my. There’s no Nebula?"

The receptionist must have felt sympathy for my answer, and suddenly started saying something strange.

"It looks like some crazy sponsor is pushing their incarnation to death again. Were you also deceived by a story like 'A dragon arises in a stream'?"

There seems to be a story like that.

"I don’t know where you came from and what you heard, but if possible, it would be best to just go back. An incarnation like you will become prey as soon as you enter."

"Thank you, but I would like to go to the 'Recycling Center'."

The receptionist, who didn't know my situation, shook his head as if another pathetic fool had appeared.

"Yeah, well. It’s your life. I have to ask you a few questions to pass, is that okay?"

I nodded.

"Where are you from?"

"Seoul Dome."

"Do you have any stories?"

"Yes."

"How many stories do you have?"

"There are three that I have accumulated myself."

"You accumulated three stories yourself…"

The guide who had written down that far stopped and asked.

"Count the stories. You piled it all up? Who recommended this?"

"The Demon King of Salvation."

I thought he might know my background, but the guide was wearing sheep's clothing so I couldn't tell his expression.

The guide who checked something nodded and asked.

"Your name is?"

I was about to answer Cheon Inho, but hesitated for a moment.

"Your name is?"

I don't know why.

However, I had a feeling that I shouldn't say that.

"I asked your name. I’m sure you didn’t forget it, right?"

[The guide doubts your identity.]

[If you answer the wrong name, you will be immediately kicked out.]

"There are a lot of unusual friends today. Including the black haired and black clothed kid who came in earlier…"

I thought of the Demon King of Salvation.

"I'll tell you in advance, if you say the wrong name, you will be immediately expelled. Only invited incarnations can come here—"

My playful Constellation.

It was he who let me in here.

"My name is—"

I slowly said one person's name.

The guide looked at me for a moment and said.

"That's a strange name."

"I hear that a lot."

"Welcome to the 'Recycling Center', Kim Dokja."

I nodded.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 720 Episode 27 Recycling Center (3)

"Now, choose this before you go in."

The guide searched in her arms and immediately handed me a catalog.

In the catalog, there was a drawing of an animal-shaped mask similar to the one worn by the guide.

"What is this?"

"This is the mask you will use there."

Some masks are tigers, some masks are rabbits, and some masks are snakes.

I realized the identity of the masks without difficulty.

This is the 'zodiac sign'.

Rat, cow, tiger, rabbit, dragon, horse, sheep, monkey, chicken, dog, and even pig.

There are twelve animal gods that Koreans memorize as 'Jinsaomi Shinyusulhae'.

"You’d better choose carefully. You’ll be taking the placement test soon."

Placement test.

Does that mean that I will soon be taking a test related to the Chinese zodiac?

It was something that did not appear in the 'Ways of Survival' that I had been reading for the past week.

It was said that the 'Recycling Center' has a slightly different worldview in each round, so is that the case this time as well?

After thinking carefully, I chose a mask.

"Then I will do this."

What I chose was the white rat mask. The receptionist waved his hand as if he knew that would happen.

"It’s too bad, but someone already took it."

When I looked closely, the catalog indicated that it was in stock.

"There are almost no masks left in stock?"

"Heh, that’s right. They usually make a reservation before coming in."

"Reservation?"

"Sometimes it is done by a sponsor, and sometimes it is made by an incarnation who researched it in advance and made a reservation…"

I wondered if my sponsor had reserved a mask for me, but I had no chance.

I ended up choosing the only mask that was in stock. It was a white mask without any animal images engraved on it.

"It’s a free ride. There are no advantages, but there are also no disadvantages. It’s only 500 coins."

"Does this place also accept coins?"

"Shouldn’t we make a living too?"

Either prepare the items properly and say something like that.

The guide cleared his throat and added.

"Hmm, and it’s not necessarily a disadvantage to be free of face. In fact, it’s good because you don’t stand out."

The following slogan was blinking next to him:

「Are you tired of the glares from the Constellations? Are you frustrated by the tyranny of Giant Nebulae? Do you think the stories you have built up are too ordinary?」

「There are no useless stories in this world.」

「Dream of becoming a Constellation. Achieve it right now at the 'Recycling Center'.」

I looked at the slogan for a moment and said.

"Here are 500 coins."

"Good luck."

The moment I put on the mask, I felt a light breeze envelop my whole body.

[Item 'Faceless Mask' was used.]

[Your personal information is protected due to the effect of 'free access'.]

As I entered the open space inside the gathering area, the first thing I saw was the running track. The track was divided into a total of twelve lanes.

On the side of the track, there were a bunch of people who came before me, and most of them were faceless masked like me.

As expected, the majority of people are behind the scenes.

Of course, there was one incarnation that particularly stood out among them.

At first glance, his physique looks like he is no older than ten years old. The moment I saw the kid with his body covered in black rags, I remembered that the guide had mentioned the word 'black kid' earlier.

Interestingly, the guy was wearing a 'white rat mask'.

Judging from his outfit, it doesn't seem like he met a nice Constellation, so did he buy the mask himself?

"Huh? There’s number 12! Nice to meet you!"

When I turned to the direction the voice came from, I saw a man with '11' written on his chest waving his hand in that direction.

"You’re the last player in our group, right?"

"I guess so."

I answered by looking at the number '12' written on my chest.

If this is really a test related to the 'Zodiac', the number '12' would be the last one.

Man number 11 smiled broadly.

Judging from his tone of voice and gestures, the man seemed to have a quite sociable personality.

I immediately activated [Character List].

['Character List' is not available in this region.]

[The use of skills is prohibited in this area.]

The use of skills is prohibited?

Honestly, I was a little surprised.

[Character List isn't an ordinary skill, but even that has been restricted?]

Man number 11, unaware that his identity was at stake, looked at me with curious eyes and asked.

"So you also chose the Faceless mask?"

"Actually, I was going to choose a different mask."

"Do you mean a rat mask?"

I hesitated and nodded. Man number 11 seemed to have thought the same thing.

Well, it's a thought that anyone who knows even a little bit about the 'Zodiac' lore would think.

But the man who looked at me for a moment fell silent and said.

"Well, you’re lucky."

I was lucky? It's not a bad thing?

As I was about to ask what it meant, a small screen appeared in the center of the track.

The screen showed the twelve people who had participated in the race before us.

As expected, they, wearing their own masks just like us, ran to the end of their respective lanes and reached the finish line one by one.

The moment when the eleventh incarnation finally crossed the finish line.

—Oh, no…!

The last incarnation, who had not yet crossed the finish line, collapsed in despair.

—Sa-save me, please! Help me! I don't want to go back...!

The center of the track disappeared like a sinkhole, and the incarnation fell to the ground.

The eyes of the incarnation watching his fall were all the same. They seemed to be thinking roughly that no matter what happens, they won't end up like that.

When I looked to the side, I saw that man number 11 was also slightly frightened.

I asked him cautiously.

"If he’s lucky, maybe he’ll survive?"

This world is 'Ways of Survival'.

There are plenty of flying skills and items. I myself had 'Sylphid’s Jumping Boots'.

If the only elimination penalty is 'falling', there is a good chance that the man is alive.

However, man number 11 seemed to have a slightly different idea.

"Are you serious?"

"Yes?"

"The 'fall' here has a symbolic meaning."

Suddenly, the expression about the 'Recycling Center' written in 'Ways of Survival' came to mind.

「The graveyard of all possibilities in the world.」

A place where incarnations gather where only one possibility remains, and where there is no longer a hill to cling to.

"Because all the incarnations that come in here admit that they are 'scenario trash'."

The final destination of those who were not selected by a giant nebula or a powerful Constellation.

"If you fall from here, there is no place to return to. Even if you go outside, you will only suffer a miserable death."

"But there is a chance of sponsorship."

"It looks like Constellations are pretty nice over there."

I realized it again.

It did hit. The Constellations in the <Star Stream> were such beings.

I answered with a bitter smile.

"No, my Constellation was very poor."

"Really? Then you can’t fall for that either."

"Yes, I will definitely become a Constellation."

Constellation. That was the purpose of my going up to this 'Recycling Center'.

"If you fully graduate from the 'Recycling Center', you can become a Constellation."

Even though I knew the information from 'Ways of Survival', there were still many secrets in the 41st Round.

In order to retrieve the 'Demon King of Salvation' who contributed to the scenario, and to prevent this '41st Round' from ending in destruction.

I needed to be at least on equal footing with the stars in the sky.

"Haha, a Constellation. You have big dreams. I don't expect that much, but it would be nice to be recognized by small and medium-sized Constellations. If you're lucky enough to get noticed by the Center Director, even better—"

"Who is the Center Director?"

"I don't know either. He's never revealed his identity. All I know is that he's the head of the Small and Medium Nebula Alliance."

The head of the Small and Medium Nebula Alliance?

I thought about the contents of 'Ways of Survival', but I had never read anything like that.

Is this also a feature unique to the 41st Round?

[New sub-scenario has arrived!]

A scenario message rang in my ears just at the right time.

It was finally our turn.

**<Sub-scenario — Chinese Zodiac Race>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: C

Clear conditions: Avoid finishing last in the Zodiac Race.

Time limit: 10 minutes

Reward: Entry to the 'Recycling Center'.

Different rewards are paid according to rank.

Failure: Expulsion from the 'Recycling Center'.

I immediately checked the 'different rewards list'.

Of all the items, the one that caught the most attention was the second place product.

> 2nd place. Fragment of the story「The Right Arm of the Sword Master Who Was Stabbed in the Back by a Colleague」.

I blankly read the product name.

It's definitely true.

This fragment clearly belonged to the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

But why is it here now?

「The Demon King of Salvation became part of the 'scenario'.」

Could it be that this was what it meant?

I don't know.

Anyway, once I learned of the existence of this fragment, I couldn't pretend not to know.

However, as I looked through the list, there was one item that bothered me just as much as the story fragments.

> 1st place. Item 'Battle boots of the noble one'...

The moment I saw the shiny black combat boots, my mouth opened without me knowing.

No, why is it here?

It couldn't have happened.

Because the owner of that item is already—

"Anyway, this time I just don’t have to finish last. Then I can qualify to enter the Recycling Center."

Man number 11, who had no idea how I felt, wiped his nose and held out his hand.

"Now that I think about it, I haven’t even said my name properly. My name is Weilong Wang."

I thought as I held the man's hand without showing it.

「Weilong, King of Bicheonhori.」

I thought something was strange from the beginning.

Who would have guessed that Bicheonhori, one of the 100 strongest members of the 'Ways of Survival' and Yoo Joonghyuk's tactician, was this man.

By the way, seeing as his way of speaking hasn't changed like that of a martial artist, it seems like he hasn't visited the <Second Murim> yet.

Well, it's still an early scenario.

"I am Kim Dokja."

"Okay, Kim Dokja-ssi. Why don’t we join forces?"

"Do you mean to form an alliance?"

"Only for this game."

The goal of this race is to cross the finish line without being in last place.

In other words, Bicheonhori’s proposal was clear.

"Only one person needs to fall in this match."

At the same time, Bicheonhori’s eyes turned somewhere.

I turned my head to follow his gaze and paused. A pitch-black kid wearing a 'white rat mask' was there.

"Honestly, I don’t feel like it."

"Why? Is it because he’s a kid?"

When I didn't answer easily, Bicheonhori shook his head.

"Kim Dokja-ssi, you are naive. No one knows whether that incarnation is a child or not."

Of course it is like this.

The same applies even to children. Like the children of the Beggar Sect, there are many children in this apocalypse who deceive or kill adults.

However, the reason I am reluctant is.

"It’s just because I don’t like obvious stories."

"The obvious?"

Bicheonhori blinked his eyes several times and slowly nodded.

"Kim Dokja-ssi, you are an unusual person."

[Each player is requested to enter the lane.]

[The 'Zodiac Race' will begin shortly.]

The incarnations who heard the system message entered the lane one by one.

Bicheonhori, standing next to me, relaxed slightly and said.

"But keep in mind, that kid is going to die anyway. He chose the 'white rat mask'."

I couldn't ask what that meant. Because the countdown was starting right in front of my eyes.

[The use of items, souls, and skills is restricted in this race.]

['Zodiac Race' begins!]

With a bang, the incarnations all started at once. Although their running postures were different, everyone had a serious expression on their faces.

This race is a competition based on pure physical ability. Skills, items, and the power of the sponsor cannot be borrowed.

However, there was one force that prevailed in this 'Prosperous Domain'

The scenery around the area began to sway, and although it was only a slight level, an air current of 'staging' was created.

[The story latent on stage begins!]

And then the pitch-black kid started running ahead of the incarnations.

[The story 'The Winning Rat' begins its storytelling!]

As expected, the pitch-black kid seemed to know about the story of the 'Zodiac Race'.

"The 'Zodiac Race' is a story in which the white rat wins."

The problem is that it was not only the little boy who knew this story.

A sharp shuriken flew into the kid's back with a 'snap' sound.

The kid barely managed to avoid the first shuriken by taking steps, but he couldn't even avoid the kick of another incarnation that was quickly approaching.

With a light groan, the little boy tripped over a rock and fell.

"You idiot. How dare you choose 'rat'?"

In an instant, five or six incarnations rushed in and started trampling on the kid.

The kid couldn't even scream and was beaten.

Arms, legs, shoulders.

Although he was crouching down to reduce the impact, it was clear that the kid would no longer be able to run again.

What the incarnations need is 'one dropout'.

And just now, the incarnations decided that the one eliminated would be that kid.

"I told you so."

Bicheonhori glanced at the little boy as if there was nothing he could do, then looked back at me and said,

"It was a decided game anyway."

After leaving those words, Bicheonhori ran away.

The end of the track was far away, and the leading incarnation was already far ahead. If I delayed any longer, I wouldn't be able to catch up with them.

[The 'Recycling Center' responds to your choices.]

The kid was struggling and grabbing the dirt on the floor. It looked like he was trying to get up, but his legs seemed to have no strength at all. The ligaments may have been torn.

I walked towards the kid.

"Get on my back."

The pitch-black kid looked up at me. I could see the guy’s round eyes beyond the white rat mask. His eyes trembled inexplicably, as if he couldn't understand my choice.

"Quickly. Are you going to be eliminated like this?"

Eventually, the kid who hesitated grabbed my shoulder. I put the kid on my back and then got up and started running.

The kid who was breathing hard behind my back said.

"What are you doing?"

"What?"

"If you save me, you too will be eliminated."

The kid on my back let out a gruff voice. I chuckled because the way he spoke seemed exactly like a cirtain someone.

"Are you saying thank you?"

"Something like clumsy sympathy—"

"I don’t pity you."

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor increases.]

"I saved you because I wanted to win, my goal is not to avoid last place."

"What—"

My physical ability was now superior to that of any other incarnation of the same level.

That's because my overall abilities have reached the scenario limit standard.

However, the distance was so far that it was impossible to catch up with that alone.

Nevertheless, I faithfully ran while carrying the little boy on my back.

How long did I run like that?

The distance that seemed impossible to catch up began to narrow little by little.

The kid let out a startled voice.

"How—"

It wasn't just the kid. The incarnations, who realized I was pursuing them, were looking back one by one with wide eyes.

I smiled at them and opened my mouth.

"You don’t know how the rat won?"

"You guy, you can’t—"

The fact that 'the rat wins' the 'Zodiac Race' is already widely known. That's why the incarnation who wears the 'rat mask' is under the greatest pressure.

However, the incarnations were so obsessed with the fact that 'the rat wins' that they forgot one important fact.

[The story of the 'Zodiac' responds to your choice!]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Won the Rat’ watches your choice with interest.]

[The spirit of a charging bull pervades your entire body!]

['Simple staging' begins!]

The reason I saved the kid is simple.

If it were Kim Dokja, he would definitely have made this choice.

「An animal carrying a 'rat' can definitely take 'second place' in this race.」

That's it.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 721 Episode 27 Recycling Center (4)

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The other incarnations stretched out their hands towards me. I dodged their hands with quick movements and kicked the floor. As the acceleration began to pick up, the incarnations began to move backwards one by one.

"How could that—"

"He’s carrying a kid!"

11th, 10th, 9th, 8th…

A ranking that goes up in an instant.

As the acceleration increased to the point where I was right in front of the leading incarnation, the back of Bicheonhori, who had run ahead, came into view.

He exclaimed in admiration as he rose to the top of the rankings with his uniquely agile legs.

"Huh, that’s a novel method."

Fortunately, Bicheonhori did not attack me.

"Are you using the story of the 'Rat'?"

I nodded.

Originally, the 'Zodiac Race' was a story in which the 'rat' won.

To be exact, it is a story about a 'rat' riding on the back of a faithfully running 'bull' and winning.

In other words, I was now playing the role of a 'bull' carrying a rat.

['Simple staging' is in effect!]

「Simple staging.」

It was difficult to expect the same effect as the general「Staging」, but in a situation where the skill and stigmata were sealed, this was an excellent buff.

Even that quick-footed Bicheonhori was slowly falling behind me.

"It’s not over yet. Don’t let your guard down."

Bicheonhori warned.

"All the incarnations that have come here are poisonous people."

Before he could finish speaking, one of the incarnations of the leading group threw a shuriken towards me.

I quickly ducked to avoid the shuriken, then took a big step and hit the guy hard on the back.

"Ugh!"

As the incarnation who had been hit on the back rolled around on the floor, the other incarnations in the lead group also joined in with murderous looks in their eyes.

"You can’t go! Stop him!"

Yes, whatever.

How can they stop me in a situation where their stigmata and skills are sealed?

Of course, there are ways to use 'stories', but an incarnation that can handle 'story' in only the eighth scenario is—

"Tie his feet!"

I thought it was rare.

[Fragment of the story 'The Farmer Plowing' begins its storytelling!]

Coo coo coo coo coo.

[Fragment of the story 'The Farmer Plowing' ruined the farming!]

I felt like my feet were sinking into the track I was running on, but soon the terrain changed to become as uneven as a furrow in a field.

「The farmer plowing a field.」

Did they have 'land reclamation experts' or 'developers of rice transplanting methods' as hints?

However, using that fragment of the story was a mistake.

Because now I was under the protection of 'Bull'.

[The energy of a charging bull explodes from your body!]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Won the Rat' grins.]

Originally, bulls did the field work.

"Damn, he’s faster!"

"It’s stupid, because you use fragments like that!"

The leading incarnations were embarrassed and attacked each other, blaming each other.

I struck a spear lightly with 'Unbreakable Faith' and took the lead.

Now there are only two incarnations left in front of us.

One incarnation, who was running in second place, blew toward the floor.

[Fragment of the story 'Sigh of the Frozen One' begins its storytelling!]

I felt my leg muscles rapidly becoming stiff due to the cold wind.

[Story fragment 'Sigh of the Frozen One' wraps around your ankles.]

I never thought there would already be incarnations that can handle fragments of stories to this extent.

I checked the stories I had in my head. But I couldn't think of a story that was particularly suitable for this situation.

At that time, the kid on my back opened his mouth.

"Keep running."

[The story fragment 'Scream of the Scorching Flame' begins its storytelling!]

I was a little surprised.

「Scream of a Scorching Flame.」

It happened to be a fragment of a story I read about in 'Ways of Survival'.

A fragment that can only be obtained by those who fought against the 'Red Flame Dragon', one of the kings of the dragon race.

However, it was a story that made no common sense. Is there any chance of an incarnation fighting against the Red Flame Dragon in only the eighth scenario?

Unless he happened to pick up a fallen piece of story—

[The story fragment 'Scream of a Scorching Flame' melts the cold.]

The kid shouted with a frown, probably because it seemed like using the fragment of the story was too difficult.

"There's no time! Faster! I must come in first place!"

Now there is only one incarnation left at the forefront.

Before I knew it, the finish line began to appear in the distance. But with the finish line just around the corner, the incarnation, who was running in front of me, looked back.

It was an incarnation wearing a tiger mask.

"He’s quite the guy."

Contrary to what Bicheonhori said, the 'Recycling Center' was not necessarily a place where only weak people gathered.

[Fragment of the story 'The Chosen One of Self-defense' begins its storytelling.]

When weak animals gather together, there are bound to be wild beasts that come to hunt those weak animals.

The leading incarnation was also that kind of guy.

His hands swelled greatly and soon took on the shape of a tiger's front paws.

Looking at the fragments of the story, it may be an incarnation related to the 'tiger' in the Chinese Zodiac.

I asked breathlessly.

"Do you know the ´Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'?"

The tiger mask's shoulders trembled at the words I suddenly shouted.

I continued with a grin.

"He’s a friend who sponsors me often."

"Don’t lie! A Historical-grade Constellation is with you—"

"Tiger Eating Rice Cakes! Are you watching!"

The surprised guy looked up into space. Unfortunately, there was no response from the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

But it didn't matter. I just needed an opportunity to catch up with him.

"You bastard!"

Before I knew it, the tiger mask found me running alongside him and lashed out with its ferocious front paw.

I supported the kid's butt with one hand and swung 'Unbreakable Faith' with the other hand.

[The story 'Tenacious Martial Arts Expert' begins its storytelling!]

I wonder if my level has improved considerably during this time. The feeling of holding a Narrative-grade story in my hands was quite different.

As 'Unbreakable Faith' spewed out magical power and unleashed harsh energy, the Tiger Mask’s eyes widened.

"It’s not a fragment of a story, it’s a real 'story'…?"

As the blade wrapped with the power of stories collided with the forepaw, a series of magical waves erupted.

[The story 'Tenacious Martial Arts Expert' stutters its storytelling.]

Perhaps because it was not a story I had built up myself, the story of the Ark did not demonstrate satisfactory destructive power.

It might also mean that my level is not good enough yet.

But it's only a Narrative-grade story.

I realized once again that there was still a long way to go.

"Gaaaa! I can’t lose! Self-defense! Give me the energy of a tiger!"

A bright blue aura soared from the whole body of the guy who shouted a strange slogan.

While I was blocking the flying front paw, the tiger mask began to take three or four steps ahead of me.

There are now about 100 meters left until the finish line.

The products for this scenario were on display inside the finish line visible in the distance.

Fragments of Kim Dokja’s story.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' is craving it.]

'If you want to eat, help me, you bastard.'

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' snorts as if it is annoyed.]

At that moment, fierce magical power surged from my right arm.

"Kaaaaak!"

While the tiger mask, unable to withstand the impact of the magic wave, was rolling around on the floor, I jumped over him and sprinted as fast as I could.

It would be nice to win first place like this, but unfortunately, that is impossible since I have claimed the role of 'Bull'.

If we lose first place here, we'll probably be swept up in the possible aftermath of a 'simple staging'.

"Kid. Go."

The kid grabbed my shoulder as if asking if I was really going to be okay.

"It’s okay. Anyway, what I want is the second-place product."

"You are such a strange person."

"In times like that, you say 'thank you'."

The kid just kicked my shoulder and crossed the finish line.

"I am indebted to you."

A very thin and faint voice remained behind the guy soaring into the sky.

I smiled bitterly without realizing it.

In fact, that was a huge step forward.

If that kid is 'the guy' I think of.

[Sub-scenario has ended!]

[You have successfully completed the 'Zodiac Race'.]

[You finished the 'Zodiac Race' in 'second place'.]

[Obtained the story fragment 'The Right Arm of the Sword Master who was Stabbed in the Back by a Colleague'.]

[The constellation 'The One Who Won the Rat' is satisfied with your reproduction of the story.]

[The constellation 'The One Who Won the Rat' sponsors you with 1,000 coins.]

「Permission to enter the 'Recycling Center' has been obtained.」

Afterwards, the incarnations crossed the finish line one by one.

"I lived! Damn it!"

"Constellation-nim! I passed!"

"No! I don't want it! Argh!"

A sinkhole occurred on the track, and the incarnation, who came in last place, crashed.

Unfortunately, the person who was eliminated was the incarnation of the Historical-grade who was trading blows with me until the very end. It looks like he suffered quite serious internal injuries from the impact of the final clash.

I immediately checked the prize I had won.

「'The Right Arm of the Sword Master who was Stabbed in the Back by a Colleague'.」

This is a fragment of a story that Kim Dokja obtained from 'Scenario Horizon', and a fragment of story that the 'Demon King of Salvation' used to save me.

The moment I activated the fragment, I felt a surge of strength in my right arm and heard a nostalgic voice.

「Well done, Youngest.」

I couldn't tell if it was really something he left behind, or if it was accidentally buried in the fragments of this story.

However, the moment I heard that voice, I was reminded again of what I had to do.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' nods.]

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' declares that it will eat now.]

What?

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' feasts on the story fragment 'The Right Arm of the Sword Master who was Stabbed in the Back by a Colleague'!]

[A 15-day time limit has been added.]

[The status of the story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' increases slightly.]

[Understanding of the story fragment 'The Right Arm of the Sword Master who was Stabbed in the Back by a Colleague' has greatly increased!]

The stories it preyed upon did not disappear. Rather, understanding of the story increased.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' looks at you as if you are pitiful.]

If you think about it, it was natural.

The 'Heir to the Eternal Name' is a story that exists to complete 'The One and Only Kim Dokja'.

There is no way Kim Dokja could not use the power he had.

"You’re really fast. I’m impressed."

Bicheonhori, who came in third place, patted his pants and said.

The third place prize is 'Shoes of Greed'.

Although it was a somewhat inferior item compared to 1st and 2nd place, he seemed satisfied.

"Do you have company? If you don't mind, I think it would be nice if I could accompany you inside the Center."

Bicheonhori was the only incarnation that didn't attack me, so there was nothing wrong with going around with him. But...

"I have company."

I saw the pitch-black kid holding the first prize from a few steps away.

Bicheonhori asked in a somewhat surprised voice.

"Were you with that kid?"

"To be exact, we will be joining the group soon."

I left behind Bicheonhori, who was tilting his head as if wondering what that meant, and went straight to the pitch black kid.

The kid was mumbling as he held on with both hands to the 'Battle Boots of the Noble One' given as the first prize.

"I finally found it..."

I wonder if my eyes looked like that when I got the fragment of the story of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Anyone can see the sparkle in the eyes of a child who has recovered a precious item.

"Is it important to you?"

The little boy didn't answer. Of course, it wasn't a question I wanted an answer to.

Because I already knew what those boots meant to him.

I thought of lonely footprints in a distant snow field.

「"Captain, but why don’t your feet smell?"」

5th Round.

「"Master, can I put a sticker here?"」

98th Round.

「"Are you planning on exchanging those boots for my military boots?"」

186th Round.

No matter what round he lived in, he was always wearing those battle boots.

As the rounds changed, the stickers Lee Jihye had put on and all traces of Lee Hyunsung's blood disappeared, but he continued to wear those boots.

He put on those boots and walked the same path again and again.

"Please stop and confess now."

At my question, the pitch-black kid looked up at me.

"Why on earth did you become like that?"

I was suspicious from the first time I saw it.

My doubts turned into certainty right after I saw the fragment of the story of the 'Red Flame Dragon' that he had.

There is no way in this world line that there will be an incarnation that has already met the 'Red Flame Dragon'.

Except for just one person.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

If it was Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round, it wouldn't be surprising if he had fragments of that story.

He will have already had experience facing the 'Red Flame Dragon' in the 40th Round.

Anyway, it was fortunate to be reunited with Yoo Joonghyuk here.

The eighth scenario was the 'Recycling Center', which Kim Dokja also avoided.

He was unconscious when fighting the Constellations, so he wasn't helpful at all, but as long as Yoo Joonghyuk stays sane, there's nothing to be afraid of no matter what scenario comes for the time being.

"I was wondering if you wanted me to pay for my meal, but then you asked why I turned into a kid."

The problem is that body, which has become weak even at first glance.

Who would think that scrawny figure is that 'Yoo Joonghyuk'?

"I don’t know what you’re talking about. Get out of the way."

Is he trying to hide his identity?

But there was something strange about him for me to think that way and move on.

In the <Star Stream>, fame soon becomes a story. Yoo Joonghyuk, who knows this well, had no reason to hide his identity.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

At that moment, my Constellation's words came to mind along with an ominous premonition.

「'Redemption of Truth' is a power that can be used at the cost of some of the memories of the past.」

No way.

I looked down at little Yoo Joonghyuk. Then little Yoo Joonghyuk also looked up at me.

Little Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been glaring at me with his characteristic gaze for a long time, asked with a frown.

"Who on earth is Yoo Joonghyuk?"

For a moment, all kinds of thoughts came into my head and then became quiet.

I slowly opened my mouth, looking into the clear eyes of little Yoo Joonghyuk, who did not show any lies.

"Yoo Joonghyuk…"

The last thing I thought of was Yoo Joonghyuk from the 1,863rd Round.

My favorite Yoo Joonghyuk.

I smiled kindly at little Yoo Joonghyuk.

"This is a friend who really likes dirt."

Finally, the opportunity to change the 41st Round has come.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 722 Episode 27 Recycling Center (5)

Throughout the rounds of 'Ways of Survival', Yoo Joonghyuk lost his memory several times.

At the edge of the 800th Round, he met an outer deity belonging to the 'Great Ancient One' and his spirit collapsed.

Around the 1150th Round, he was caught up in the Giant Nebula's 'Regressor Dissection Plan' and became a test subject for the Nebula for a while.

Sometimes, like when 'Mad Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' was born through a wrong transfusion of Lee Hyunsung’s military stories, not only did he lose his memory, but his personality itself completely changed.

But has he ever become as small as he is now?

At least it doesn't appear in the 'Ways of Survival' that I remember. Of course, it appears once in 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint'…

Watching Yoo Joonghyuk move his small hands to put on his battle boots, I had a really strange feeling.

Should we really recognize this creature as Yoo Joonghyuk?

[The Constellation 'The One Who Won the Rat' thinks the 'little rat' is cute.]

Is there something going wrong in this world?

"You're a really good runner."

One by one, the incarnations who had completed acquiring their respective prizes gathered by my side.

"It was an amazing response. I never thought you would use stories in such a way... It would be nice if we could work in the same area at the Center."

"Which district will you choose? Why not join us?"

"I'm holding the 'pig' side of the line. If you join me, I can connect you to that side too…"

Same area. Apparently, the 'Recycling Center' is divided into sections.

[The lower level of the 'Recycling Center' is the area of the Nebula 'Zodiac'.]

Also.

[1st, 2nd, and 3rd places in the 'Zodiac Race' will be given 'Zone Priority Selection'.]

I answered, asking for understanding from the gathered incarnations.

"I'm sorry, but I don't have any plans to choose a specific faction yet."

Of course, it would be nice to get on the line. But now was not the time to make that decision.

Some of the incarnations looked disappointed at my answer, while others frowned and swore.

Bicheonhori, who was watching the scene from the side, nodded his head. He didn't show any signs of being angry or disappointed with my choice.

"Good. Choosing nothing is also a choice."

"Nowadays, such choices have become commonplace."

"Oh."

Bicheonhori must have thought what I said was interesting, so he took out a notebook and started writing down something.

"You said your name was 'Kim Dokja', right?"

"Yes."

Come to think of it, he was the person who wrote the famous book on characters, "The 100 Strongest People".

Bicheonhori must have noticed my gaze and made an answer.

"Oh, because records are my hobby."

Is it okay?

What would happen if 'Kim Dokja' was listed as one the 'Strongest 100 People'? I guess that means the future will be transformed too seriously.

"Hmm. I guess this is what happens this time…"

This time?

Bicheonhori muttered something meaningful and smiled slightly as he looked at me.

"I hope we get a chance to meet again, young man."

Did something just change in his tone of voice?

With those last words, Bicheonhori chose his 'Zone' and disappeared into the Recycling Center.

I felt a little disappointed, but I didn't really care. Since we were destined to go to the same 'Recycling Center' anyway, there would be another opportunity to talk, as he said.

I checked the 'zone selection message' that appeared before my eyes.

[You can select a total of 12 areas.]

[Select an entry area.]

As previously explained, the 'lower level' of the Recycling Center is the area of the Nebula Zodiac.

There were twelve zones according to the tendencies of each Zodiac Sign, and incarnations could choose the zone they wanted.

[Zone 1 - Rat-district (자 동)]

[Zone 2 - Bull-district (축 동)]

[Zone 3 - Tiger-district (인 동)]

[Zone 4 - Rabbit-district (묘 동)]

[Zone 5 - Dragon-district (진 동)]

[Zone 6 - Snake-district (사 동)]

[Zone 7 - Horse-district (오 동)]

[Zone 8 - Goat-district (미 동)]

[Zone 9 - Monkey-district (신 동)]

[Zone 10 - Rooster-district (유 동)]

[Zone 11 - Dog-district (술 동)]

[Zone 12 - Pig-district (해 동)]

From the rat that belongs to 'Ja' to the pig that belongs to 'hae'.

If I were Dansu ahjussi or Sein-ssi, which one would I have chosen?

Looking at the results, little Yoo Joonghyuk was also staring at the options with serious eyes.

"Which one will you choose?"

"It’s none of your business."

Of course you would say this.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Won the Rat' recommends Zone 2 – 'Bull-district' to you.]

The One Who Won the Rat.

Judging by the modifier, that Constellation was the Constellation corresponding to 'Bull' in the Zodiac.

Considering that I came in second place in the Zodiac Race and that one of the Constellations that sponsored me in the beginning was the 'original bull', it wasn't a bad idea to choose 'Bull-district', which corresponds to 'bull'.

[The Constellation 'The Dog That Threw Itself into the Flames' pays attention to your choice.]

Zone 11, Dog-district, represented by 'dog', was also worth considering. 'The Dog That Threw Itself into the Flames' is the only Constellation that took Kim Dokja's side even in the main story. Maybe this is the time to build a relationship.

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' pays attention to your choice.]

Nail-Eating Rat.

Were you watching too?

If I was conscious of the 'Zodiac Race', it was also a good idea to select Zone 1, where the winner of the story, the 'Rat', belongs.

However, on the 'rat' and 'snake' side, there are Constellations of the Misreading Association.

If you want to catch a tiger, you have to go into the tiger's den. One way would be to choose their base...

Tiger.

Come to think of it, I had forgotten about the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

Considering my promise to him, Zone 3 'Tiger-district' was a good choice. The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' has helped me and shown me favor at times.

It's strange that the indirect message of 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is not heard at all, but...

In addition, I could also choose 'Zone 5 - Dragon-district', represented by the dragon, or 'Zone 9- Monkey-district', represented by the monkey.

[1 minute left to complete selection.]

My worries didn't last long.

Because now I am 'Kim Dokja'. And what Kim Dokja will say in the face of this choice is decided.

"I will not choose any district."

"I will not choose any district."

If Ji Eunyu were next to me, she would have said, "Writer, the lines here have been copied."

But I didn't say it twice.

"You there."

Those words were just said by the little boy next to me, Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Don’t copy me."

I shrugged my shoulders without answering.

Afterwards, indirect messages flew in one after another from thin air.

[The Constellation 'The Dog That Threw Itself into the Flames' asks if you are sincere.]

[The Constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' respects your choice.]

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' feels sorry for you.]

Several people who confirmed my choice also voiced concerns.

"Are you serious? This friend is out of his mind."

"Hehe, you didn’t choose the Chinese Zodiac Signs? That’s ridiculous—"

[This decision cannot be undone.]

[Do you want to keep this selection?]

I know it's a risky choice.

However, if you choose a certain Zodiac Sign, you will eventually fall under the Constellation to which that Zodiac Sign belongs.

I don't want that situation. The 'Demon King of Salvation' must have had the same thought.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' nods.]

Little Yoo Joonghyuk and I nodded at the same time. Afterwards, a halo of light came down from the air and embraced us warmly.

[You did not select any 'Zodiac Sign'.]

[Hidden options are activated.]

[A new achievement has been achieved.]

[Zone 13 – Move to 'Void-district'.]

Zone 13, huh.

As expected, there was an option not to choose a 'Zodiac Sign'.

What unfolded before my eyes along with the warp was a city with flashing neon signs. The buildings are somehow reminiscent of the Earth of the near future. The lights of a skyscraper flashing in the distance.

No matter how you look at it, it was a scene that was somewhat far from the world view of the 'Zodiac'.

This is Zone 13?

[Linked scenario activates!]

**<Main Scenario #8 - Zone 13>**

Category: Main

Difficulty:???

> Clear conditions: ???
>
> Time limit: —
>
> compensation: ???
>
> Failure: —

The title of the main scenario was also changed. However, key details such as clear conditions and rewards were still not revealed.

We have to find out for ourselves.

[Linked scenario activates!]

[An 'event scenario' occurs every night in this area.]

It is an event scenario that occurs every night.

This feels a bit like déjà vu.

[You can obtain rewards when you survive the event scenario.]

As I lightly scanned the street, I saw incarnations glancing at us.

Most of them were beasts.

A giraffe with one leg replaced by a machine. An elephant with broken tusks. A lion with all its fur removed and one eye missing.

Looking closely, I saw that it wasn't just the prisoners. Other races with animal origins, such as orcs and gnomes, were also seen.

What they have in common is that they are also equipped with mechanical arms or mechanical legs.

It was a worldview reminiscent of cyberpunk.

[Tonight’s event is 'The Three Little Pigs'.]

[Find an 'accommodation' before the event starts and survive.]

[One hour left until the event starts.]

Still, there was a good beginner's guide.

One hour isn't that much time. I need to hurry up a bit.

I glanced at little Yoo Joonghyuk and started walking away, leaving him behind.

I felt someone following me a few steps away.

After walking about twenty steps, I deliberately stopped. Then the sound of following footsteps disappeared.

As I started walking again, the sound of hesitant footsteps followed.

I grinned and looked back.

"Why are you following me?"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk, startled, froze in place.

"Because I’m suspicious of you."

This was little Yoo Joonghyuk, who followed me eagerly, dragging his big boots.

If the Demon King of Salvation had heard this, he would never have believed it.

"Tie your shoelaces properly."

"It’s tied up."

The shoelaces were tied in a mess.

"Do you know that there is a special option for those shoes?"

"Special options?"

"How much did you forget?"

Would I have felt this way if I had a younger sibling?

If I had a younger sibling, I thought it would be a good kid like Yoosoung.

I bowed lightly. Little Yoo Joonghyuk took a step back as if on guard, but my hands were faster.

"This is how we tie it."

'Battle Boots of the Noble One' activates special options when the shoelaces are tightened and tied in a specific way.

[The special option of the item 'Battle Boots of the Noble One' is activated!]

The basics of Yoo Joonghyuk, these battle boots had 'solid durability' and 'resistance to various properties'.

In addition, as an auxiliary option, 'phenomenal elasticity' can be activated, and the size can be adjusted comprehensively to the extent that it can handle Yoo Joonghyuk, who activated 'Gigantification'.

[The size of the item changes to suit the wearer!]

Little Yoo Joonghyuk asked, looking down at the battle boots that had been tightened to fit his feet.

"You, how do you know this?"

"Are you surprised that I know how to tie my shoelaces?"

"…"

"I want to ask you how you don’t know any of this."

"Is my name 'Yoo Joonghyuk'?"

I quietly looked into the eyes of little Yoo Joonghyuk.

According to my guess, the reason why Yoo Joonghyuk lost his memory was due to the side effects of 'Story Imprint'.

I don’t know, but it’s probably because of 'Restraint of Truth' or 'Restraint of Emotions'.

Even looking back, it was strange that Yoo Joonghyuk's combat power, when he became the 'Black Beast', did not suffer the aftereffects of probability.

"Yes. You are a dirt eater."

"I don’t eat dirt."

"Once you try it, you might change your mind."

"Do you want to die?"

"If you kill me, you will never know who you are."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk thought about something for a moment, then frowned and asked.

"What is your name?"

"It is Kim Dokja."

"That’s a strange name."

"I’m sick of hearing things like that."

Even though we didn't really talk, I somehow felt nostalgic.

"What else do you know about me?"

"Before that, what do you remember?"

"Ten days."

"Ten days?"

"After ten days, most of my memories will return."

Ten days. That's enough time.

"And that we have to find the stolen equipment."

"When was the equipment taken away?"

"I don’t know. It was like this when I woke up."

I think he lost it while climbing up the 'Star Ladder'.

Considering that Battle Boots were released as a product from the 'Recycling Center', key items such as 'Infinite Dimension Subspace Coat' and 'Wolgeuk' could have been in a similar situation.

Even if nothing else was known, 'Wolgeuk' had to be recovered. That's Yoo Joonghyuk's key weapon in the 41st Round.

"And..."

"And?"

"I have to meet a guy named Cheon Inho."

I paused for a moment.

"Why him?"

"I don’t know. I just remember that I have to meet that bastard. When I meet that bastard __"

I quietly grabbed the dirt from the floor. If this little guy remembered anything, I was going to throw dirt in his mouth and run away.

"I thought I could last at least ten days before I recovered my memory."

I was dazed for a moment and then looked down at the dirt in my hands. When I opened my tightly clenched fist, dirt flowed down.

I felt fortunate that I was still wearing the mask.

"I will accompany you for about ten days. I will help you not die."

"What are you planning?"

I said, holding out my right hand covered in dirt.

"There are conditions."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded as if he knew that would happen.

"Say it."

"You can’t kill me after ten days."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at me with an expression that he didn't know what that meant, and he held out his clean right hand.

"I don’t kill people for no reason."

"Yes, of course you won’t."

Our 'survival contract' was concluded.

And an hour later, little Yoo Joonghyuk spoke.

"I will definitely kill you, Kim Dokja."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 723 Episode 28 House (1)

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「"When he comes back, we will live in a very, very big house."」

Shin Yoosung, who was quietly looking up at the sky, said.

"The house will be so big that there is the Han River and the sea inside the house. There is also a PC room and a library. Even if you don’t go outside, you can eat pizza by the Han River or go to the sea and eat chicken. We will all go to the PC room together and talk to Joonghyuk ahjussi. We can learn games, and..."

"You idiot. There is no house that big."

Lee Gilyoung gave a scolding. Shin Yoosung was silent for a long time before answering.

"I know."

---

An hour ago, the first thing we agreed on was finding a place to stay.

"I don’t know what the scenario for the event that will be in an hour is going to be, but first, let’s find accommodation."

In fact, it's a lie to say that I don't know what's coming.

Since the name of the event scenario is 'The Three Little Pigs', a related event will definitely occur.

Fortunately, little Yoo Joonghyuk nodded without any hesitation.

"Guide me."

"Yeah."

I feel like I have somehow become a servant serving his master.

I walked along, looking closely at the signs installed throughout the city. Obviously, this place functions as a city in its own way, so there will be places that can be used as temporary accommodation.

Since it is a cyberpunk world, there might be a hotel.

"You."

"Yeah."

"You walk quickly."

I glanced back at little Yoo Joonghyuk and slowed down my pace a little.

But after a while, Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth again.

"I would have said you walk fast."

"What are you saying?"

When I turned around, Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at me without answering.

I looked at that guy and sighed.

He has a body that makes me think he's barely ten years old. Since he didd not receive the benefits of any skills or Stigmas, he must have not yet recovered from the fatigue of the previous 'Zodiac Race'.

I had no choice but to get down on my knees and stick out my back.

Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to have been waiting, and he jumped up and stood on my shoulder.

Wait No, it's like he's riding a surfboard.

"Can’t you just piggyback like a normal person?"

"It would be better to pay more attention to training."

"Huh?"

"The balance of the body was lost because the scapula and deltoid muscles are not properly developed. From now on, when holding a sword, I have to move my shoulders while paying attention to the range of motion of the wing bones."

"Isn’t it a lie to say you lost your memory?"

I grumbled and started walking, picking up little Yoo Joonghyuk.

If Uriel was watching, she would have given me coins, saying it was nice.

For some reason, the Constellations I was normally close to were nowhere to be seen here.

"But will your body return to its original state after ten days?"

"I do not know either."

"If it doesn’t come back, I’ll be in a bit of trouble."

"There will be recovery. I don’t know how much will return."

If Yoo Joonghyuk in this round didn't continue to grow up in this state, a disaster could happen.

Then what should I do?

Should I throw this little bastard into the Time Fault of the Dark Dimension and wait for him to grow up?

"I don’t know about you, but there is a place in the Dark Dimension called a Time Fault."

"Do you by any chance have a skill called [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint]?"

"What nonsense?"

"Why did you mention the Time Fault?"

"It’s a good place for a weakling like you to train his body."

Ah, did he mean that?

"Why exercise when you can increase your stats with coins?"

"It’s not 'real'."

"What is real or fake? It’s a world where coins are all you need anyway."

While we were chatting casually, we arrived at a building labeled 'Fox and Crane Hotel'.

The name is a hotel, but no matter how you look at it, it looks like an inn.

As I opened the door and entered, there was a musty smell of beer.

The prisoners sitting at the bar table gave us wary looks.

I ignored them and headed straight to the counter.

"Oh, welcome back."

The owner who found us stuttered and opened his mouth.

For reference, the owner was a crane.

"Guys, what are you doing in such a shabby place—"

"Isn’t this Iggy’s dorm?"

"Yes, yes, that’s true, but is there a place where precious Naori can stay…"

Precious Naori?

I watched our movements. Although I was wearing a nice coat, I was only clad in tangled rags. Except for wearing a mask...

「Mask.」

I felt a sense of discomfort.

Since we first entered Zone 13, Yoo Joonghyuk and I have encountered quite a few incarnations.

But they had something in common.

「No one is wearing a mask.」

Pig? I'm sure everyone came in wearing masks at first, but now—

"Are you by any chance new?"

"Yes."

"A-are you sure you didn’t choose a 'Zodiac Sign' and came directly to Zone 13?"

I nodded slightly.

The owner muttered with his eyes wide open.

"Why such a crazy choice…"

As expected, there didn't seem to be many cases of people choosing Zone 13 right away.

I guess so. It would be normal for someone to choose a zodiac sign and grow with support.

Only crazy people like Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk make choices like this.

"Do you have a room?"

"Oh, of course."

As soon as they realized we were beginners, their tone changed.

Not a very nice crane.

"How much is it?"

"One child and an adult. 2,000 coins."

No matter how you look at it, the price was exorbitant, but finding a room was the most important thing right now.

The moment 2,000 coins materialized in the palm of my hand, the owner's expression hardened.

"Are you kidding me?"

"No?"

"Hehe, it looks like you didn’t read the guide’s explanation properly."

As soon as the owner spoke, a message came into my head.

[Existing 'coins' are not distributed in this worldview.]

[The mainstream currency in this worldview is 'recycled coin'.]

Recycled coins?

"Like this."

The owner opened the cash register drawer.

I asked while looking closely at the 'recycled coins' that filled the drawer.

"Isn’t it a bottle cap?"

"This is the currency here."

From old bottle caps to new bottle caps, bottle caps of all kinds were sparkling in brilliant colors.

"Everything has its own use. This is the spirit of the 'Recycling Center'."

Is the center director’s nickname 'environmental movement expert'?

"We only have coins. Can’t we exchange money?"

Some of the people who were drinking beer took notice of us.

"Ugh, that’s what the incarnations are like these days."

"I was just trying to make everything easy."

"I heard he doesn’t know that the story he worked hard to obtain is true."

"He must be someone who only raises his abilities with coins."

Just because I tried to exchange money, I became a person who lives life easily.

When little Yoo Joonghyuk glared at them with a menacing gaze, the people immediately shut their mouths.

The owner shrugged his shoulders and answered.

"I’m sorry, but currency exchange is not possible."

"I’ll give you 10,000 coins per night."

"I said I can’t do it."

"50,000 coins per night."

"No, well—"

"100,000 coins."

The owner, who thought for a moment, looked at his guests and asked again.

"Are you serious?"

"No."

It won’t be.

"…Get some recycled coins. Night will come soon, so you’d better hurry."

We were immediately kicked out of the inn.

It looks like the currency used here must be earned here.

It's a very harsh world for beginners.

[There are 50 minutes left until today’s 'Event Scenario'.]

[Find 'accommodation' that will tolerate the room.]

Little Yoo Joonghyuk, who had already come down from my shoulder, asked.

"What are you going to do now? Didn’t you tell me to trust only you?"

"I didn’t say that."

Perhaps the 'night' of this worldview is as dangerous as the 'night' of the Demon World. That's why the message asking us to find accommodation appears again and again.

However, right now we have no way to utilize 'recycled coins'.

"What are you worrying about? Get recycled coins."

"Do you have any idea how?"

It was something I threw out without much expectations. I'm sure he'll come up with something like, "Kick down passers-by," or "Wipe down the inn and steal the lodgings and coins," or something like that, or just destroy this world.

"Buy recycled coins with coins."

I pondered the meaning of those words and asked with admiration.

"Oh, you mean give them the coins and take the recycled coins away?"

"What nonsense?"

"They say you can’t exchange money here."

If you look closely, you might find illegal money changers, but there wasn't enough time to find money changers when we didn't even know where they were.

I wonder if it would be a good idea to follow Yoo Joonghyuk's style and shake off a passerby.

"Recycled coins are bottle caps."

"Bottle caps are recycled coins."

"This means that all you have to do is get bottle caps, not recycled coins."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk said that and pointed to a street vendor. Various potions were on display at the street vendor.

I looked there in confusion and muttered.

My God, I can’t believe I didn’t think what little Yoo Joonghyuk was thinking too.

After a while, we were stacking up a bunch of potion bottles and opening the bottle caps. Of course, I didn't steal it from a street vendor, I bought it myself.

How did I purchase a potion when I didn't have any recycled coins?

[A total of 2,000 coins were spent in the 'Dokkaebi's Bag'.]

[You purchased 100 'lowest level health recovery potions whose expiration date is near'.]

We worked hard to open the bottle cap.

I opened the bottle cap and threw away the remaining potion.

[The Constellation 'Polar Bear Guardian' gapes at your judgment.]

Of course, the environment is important, but right now we have to survive. Only then can we protect polar bears.

After a while, we got the bottle caps and went back into the inn.

The owner looked shocked when he saw the bottle caps we brought.

"Aren't they all 'new bottle caps'? Could it be that you opened a potion bottle?"

"Yes."

"What happened to all the remaining potions?"

"I threw it away."

"Stupid! Just sell potions!"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk and I looked at each other with dumb expressions.

"Hmm, just kidding. Those potions are trash here anyway. The 'Recycling Center' only handles 'recycled potions'."

He was an owner who loved to joke.

"By the way, this is only worth '500 recycling coins'."

The owner clicked his tongue slightly and shook his head.

It seems to be of low value as it is the lowest level potion lid.

"Even a small room is fine. How could you not do that?"

[The 'Event Scenario' begins in 15 minutes.]

There wasn't much time left now.

If I don't find a place to stay, I might end up in a situation where I'm just opening bottles again.

It is impossible.

"Actually, there is... but would it be okay to live in a very shabby place? It would be a bit inconvenient since there are people sharing the room."

"It’s okay. Please take us there."

The owner nodded his head and gestured with his chin as if to ask us to follow. We quietly followed the owner. The owner went out of the inn and led us to the street behind the house.

"Are the accommodations outside the inn?"

"Think of it as a guest house."

After walking about a hundred meters past the inn alley, an unidentified abandoned village appeared.

"It’s here. You can go into room 101."

The place where the owner stopped was a wooden villa that looked almost collapsed.

This feels like a haunted house experience, not a guest house.

"Meals will be served in the morning, so come to the hotel when the sun rises."

"There is also breakfast service."

"Of course, that’s only if we survive until tomorrow morning."

The owner who left meaningful words disappeared and I was left alone with little Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Are you okay?"

"It doesn’t matter. I’m used to being homeless."

"Why did someone who remembers such things forget their own name?"

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't answer for a moment. I wondered what he was thinking.

A faint feeling of guilt came over me as he looked at that guy like that.

Abilities that are activated at the cost of 'normal memories' tend to disappear starting with 'unnecessary memories'.

And Yoo Joonghyuk forgot his own name before any other memory.

"It’s been a while since I went to a house."

"I’ll try to find better accommodation next time."

"It doesn’t matter."

We immediately opened the door to room 101. The noise of people making a fuss was heard from inside.

"Oh, looks like someone new has arrived."

"Welcome—"

A welcome greeting from inside the entrance. Fortunately, they seemed to be polite people.

The moment I nodded and raised my head, I made eye contact with the woman who came to meet me.

Unlike us, the face of the woman who had taken off her mask was full of vitality.

Next to her, as expected, a handsome-looking man was standing with soot smeared on his philtrum.

Before I knew it, I had no voice coming out of my throat.

「"I will not choose any district."」

Maybe I should have expected it.

If it were Kim Dokja, of course he would have had no choice but to make the same choice.

I was happy about that fact, but I was also sad, so my voice didn't come out.

Kyung Sein was the first to open her mouth.

"Ah…"

The man standing next to her also widened his eyes.

In addition, Cha Yerin, Literature Girl 64 who was sitting on a shabby chair and looked this way, and Ye Hyunwoo, the 7th Apostle, who lied helplessly on the floor and turned his head this way.

"Everyone."

The moment I barely managed to utter this word after swallowing my emotions, Ye Hyunwoo, who was lying on the floor, suddenly got up.

"No way—"

At the same time, a man leaning against the window also turned around.

I was about to nod happily and then looked down at little Yoo Joonghyuk. When I think about it, I am not Cheon Inho now.

"Nice to meet you. My name is Kim Dokja."

My companions looked blankly at my words.

Kyung Sein didn't know what to say so her lips twitched, Dansu ahjussi had a pitiful expression on his face, and Ye Hyunwoo was looking at me like I was crazy.

Only the man at the window wearing the 'black wolf mask' showed a different reaction.

Even though he was wearing a mask, it was very obvious who he was.

I don't know where he got it from, but a man wearing a black coat that resembles Yoo Joonghyuk.

"I see. I guess you've finally arrived."

Wait a minute, isn't that really Yoo Joonghyuk's coat?

"I was waiting, Kim Dokja."

[The 'Event Scenario' will begin soon.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 724 Episode 28 House (2)

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To conclude, my companions recognized me.

Who are these people?

They are monsters that have read the main story once, or up to 100 times.

Even if other people don't know, they can't not recognize me just because I'm wearing a mask.

Even the oblivious Kyung Sein asked this in a whisper.

"Are there circumstances where you have to say 'Kim Dokja'?"

The 7th Apostle Ye Hyunwoo rolled his eyes, wondering why I said that, and Literature Girl 64 Cha Yerin was looking at me with bewildered eyes.

Dansu ahjussi looked like he was worried that I might have lost my mind, and finally, Killer King—

"Yes, Kim Dokja. Are you here to see me?"

When I thought about it, that person had always called me Kim Dokja.

I ignored him and continued talking.

"The event scenario is starting soon, so let’s start preparing the scenario."

"Oh, you don’t really have to worry about that."

"Yes? Why?"

"This scenario is safe as long as you stay at home."

Is it safe to stay at home?

"The same event has happened a few times in the meantime, but it was okay as long as we stayed home."

[Event scenario will begin soon.]

[The 'Event Scenario' in question is 'The Three Little Pigs'.]

I looked closely at the scenario message flashing before my eyes.

It was strange.

If the 'Three Little Pigs' story I know is true, then this 'house' is absolutely not safe.

"By the way, Inho… No, Dokja-ssi. How did you come here?"

"It’s similar to you guys."

"Ah, as expected, Dokja-ssi…"

"It looks like you’ve been through a lot of hard times."

"Don’t talk about it."

I heard briefly about the events so far from Kyung Sein.

The group that came here from Washington via the 'Star Ladder' was put into the 'Recycling Center' scenario early on.

As we heard, Killer King, Ye Hyunwoo, and Cha Yerin each ranked in the 'Zodiac Race' and chose 'Zone 13'.

Of course I thought that would be the case for them.

If you line up the rankings of incarnations on the Korean Peninsula, they will definitely be in the top ten.

Dansu ahjussi and Kyung Sein said that although they did not take first place, they chose 'Zone 13' among the options.

"When I arrived at Zone 13, I thought it was over. Wow, this is the hidden piece I've only heard about. This is the path of a protagonist!"

It's the main character's path.

Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk would have made the same choice.

Dansu ahjussi shook his head dully.

"This is hell."

In fact, the group members seemed to be in bad condition.

Not only was Kyung Sein in shabby clothes and Lee Dansu covered in soot, but even Cha Yerin looked like a beggar, Ye Hyunwoo was lying on the floor like a lethargic patient.

Kyung Sein said, shaking her head.

"We're like that because we're hungry. We haven't eaten anything in days."

"Can't we buy something to eat?"

"I do not have money."

"Can't you just earn it?"

"Did you know that the currency here is 'recycled coins'?"

I nodded.

"Then you probably already know. The coins we collected are useless here."

"Yes, but still—"

"Oh, you just came here so you don't know much about it. After all, this place doesn't even appear in the novel."

Right. This is a place that does not appear in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

Yes, but… Do these people not know that 'recycled coins' are bottle caps?

There's no way that they don’t know what little Yoo Joonghyuk doesn't know.

"We’ve already been here for a month. We’re seniors here, so feel free to ask us anything."

"You’ve been here for a month already?"

"To be exact, a month and a week has passed!"

One month.

This meant that time inside the 'Recycling Center' passed at a different pace than the 'scenarios' on Earth.

It was a good thing for me.

The enemies I have to deal with in the future are giant Nebulae targeting the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

In order to fight them, it was necessary to reserve strength for as long as possible.

"But what’s going on outside? What about Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Everyone here is a member who entered Washington with Yoo Joonghyuk. They might be curious about what happened so far.

"Yoo Joonghyuk is safe."

"Has he defeated the Demon Marquis? I heard that it is also a difficult enemy for Yoo Joonghyuk to defeat—"

The Demon Marquis.

As expected, the group members did not seem to know what happened at the Washington Dome.

That's because they must have climbed the 'Star Ladder' before Yoo Joonghyuk turned into the 'Black Beast'.

If they knew what happened so far, they would be shocked.

…Now that I think about it, these people don't even know that I signed a contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Honestly, I didn't even know what to explain.

"No, that’s strange. Does it make sense that the 'Demon Marquis' appears in the seventh scenario?"

That doesn't make sense.

"Who on earth would beat that scenario?"

I woke up.

"I wonder if there is a Demon King of Salvation—"

The Demon King of Salvation has awakened.

"If things continue like this, huge Nebulae will soon come and ruin the entire scenario!"

What? Do you actually know everything that happened?

"Anyway, Yoo Joonghyuk has to come. There is no way to solve this scenario if the Supreme King doesn’t come."

I couldn't tell Kyung Sein, who was full of anticipation, that the kid next to me was actually Yoo Joonghyuk.

"However."

A unique ending to a speech.

It was Cha Yerin who opened her mouth.

"That."

"Yes. Please tell me."

"Little."

"Kid."

"Who?"

Why is Yerin suddenly speaking like that? The way she spoke was strange to begin with, but not to that extent.

Killer King, leaning against her window, interpreted her words.

"My sister is asking who that kid is."

The group's attention was focused on little Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Ah, this guy."

I was thinking about just saying that I picked him up on the way, but little Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth as if he had been waiting.

"I am-"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk looked back at my companions, then looked up at me one last time, frowned, and answered.

"According to this guy, my name is 'Yoo Joonghyuk'."

It was a strange introduction, but it was the best answer for the current Yoo Joonghyuk.

My companions looked at me as if they were wondering what kind of joke this was.

I sighed lightly and started talking.

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I briefly explained what had happened.

First, starting with the contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation'—

"No, who did you contract with?"

"The Demon King of Salvation."

"Who?"

"The Demon King of Salvation."

"Was he really— there?"

Looking at Kyung Sein’s almost fainting expression, I thought that if I had known that she would like it this much, I should have told her a long time ago.

"Yes."

With my answer, the house became almost festive. Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu, who were leaning on the table, embraced each other, Ye Hyunwoo, who had been lying down, got up, and Cha Yerin, who was sitting at the table, had tears in her eyes.

Everyone was happy except for Killer King, who muttered, "Then which one is the real Kim Dokja?"

To those happy people,

"Well, then the 'Demon King of Salvation' is…"

I couldn't possibly say that he was dead.

Strictly speaking, it is a bit ambiguous to say that he is 'dead'.

"He is temporarily unavailable."

"But he must be the 'Demon King of Salvation', right? Is he the 'Demon King of Salvation' we know?"

"That."

My companions held their breath and looked at me.

"He seems to have a slightly bad personality, but he is the Demon King of Salvation."

Once again, the group cheered.

"Are you sure?"

"Yes, that’s true."

I slowly laid the groundwork to calm down my excited companions.

"But he might not be able to contact you for a while. You shouldn’t expect too much—"

"What do you mean?"

How should I say it?

These are all people who have fragments of Kim Dokja. They were the people who had waited for Kim Dokja in this world more than anyone else.

How can I report the truth to such people?

"By any chance… did he die after saving you again?"

I hesitated for a moment and answered.

"That is..."

When I didn't answer for a long time, Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu, who had been embracing each other, parted ways. Cha Yerin had tears in her eyes in a different way, and Ye Hyunwoo lay down again.

Only Killer King muttered, "Kim Dokja is one again."

"What should I do! What should I do! What should I do!"

"Well, calm down."

"It’s all over now!"

Kyung Sein screamed.

"We can't use our skills, and we can't use our Stigmas ! We can't even get support from our sponsors here! We don't even have any stories, and now even Kim Dokja—"

Kyung Sein, whose spirit had collapsed upon hearing the news of the Demon King of Salvation, stumbled.

I quickly added, covering little Yoo Joonghyuk’s ears with both hands.

"It’s okay. I’ll do my best."

"Well, of course… I’m glad you came, but—"

Kyung Sein looked like she didn't know what was going on.

Still, I can't help it. The 'Demon King of Salvation' is no longer with us.

However, the Demon King of Salvation recognized me as the Youngest, so in situations where he was not around, I had to take on the role of 'Kim Dokja'.

"Even though he became a little kid, Yoo Joonghyuk came here too."

"So, why did Yoo Joonghyuk become a kid?"

"Let me explain it again…"

While the group was in confusion, Killer King with his arms crossed spoke to little Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You are not Yoo Joonghyuk."

Then little Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at me as if he was confused.

"Wasn't I Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"You can just ignore what he says."

Seriously, I want to quit being Kim Dokja.

[The 'Event Scenario' is currently in progress.]

Along with the scenario message being heard once again, the sound of an explosion was heard from afar.

I took a quick look around the house. The window frame looks like it will crumble if you just touch it, and the pillars are awkwardly erected. No matter how you looked at it, it was a roughly made wooden building.

"Let's talk about the details later. Is it really okay for it to stay like this?"

"Hey, it's okay. It's a sturdy house."

"It's okay. I've been through the same scenario several times already."

Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi answered optimistically.

I looked at the two people blankly and asked.

"What is that behind you?"

"Oh, this. Isn't it cute?"

A squirrel tail was growing behind Kyung Sein's buttocks.

It wasn't just Kyung Sein.

If you look closely, you will see that something is on the back of Dansu ahjussi.

It had a thick shell that looked like that of a turtle.

Ye Hyunwoo had panda ears sticking out on his head, and Cha Yerin... Honestly, I don't know. If you look at the way she speaks or moves, it seems like something has changed.

The only one that didn't change at all was Killer King.

Next, I heard Killer King's [Transmission] in my ears.

—These guys have already made a mistake.

Killer King was the only 'incarnation wearing a mask' among them.

A mask. It's a mask.

For reference, the following sentence appears in 'Ways of Survival' regarding masks:

「Only humans wear the mask of 'another creature' than themselves.」

Only humans.

My back felt cold.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 725 Episode 28 House (3)

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I looked closely at the faces and actions of my companions.

There were a total of four people without masks.

Kyung Sein, Dansu ahjussi, Ye Hyunwoo, and Cha Yerin. It's hard to express, but apart from their appearance, it felt like something had changed. It feels like the 'story' that makes up their essence, so to speak, has changed.

[An incarnation that loses its 'mask' will become a beast.]

In simple terms, it would mean that they have become 'animals'.

But for some reason, the moment I heard that, the expression 'beast' had a slightly different meaning.

—These guys are now prisoners of the story.

Prisoners.

—Let’s go out together for a while.

Killer King spoke in a serious tone. I once again realize that this person is someone who can speak normally.

I followed Killer King outside under the pretext of wanting to get some fresh air. Little Yoo Joonghyuk was also there.

Outside the wooden villa, rain was falling steadily. The sound of a building collapsing was heard from afar.

[The 'event scenario' is currently in progress.]

The screams of incarnations were heard one after another. A horribly spreading sibilant sound. The sound of hard flesh being torn apart.

Killer King seemed familiar with all of this and calmly took out a cigarette from his chest and asked.

Has this person always smoked?

"We were honestly confident when we first came up, because it was us and not the other incarnations."

Killer King's confidence was not strange.

These people were all 'complete readers', that is, readers who survived by going through as many as seven scenarios. Even if an unfamiliar scenario appeared, they now had the power to go through it.

Some had a good sponsor, and those who did not have a good sponsor had their own specialties.

"The positions were perfect as well. Kyung Sein is Lee Hyunsung. Lee Dansu is Lee Gilyoung. Cha Yerin is Lee Jihye. For me, Yoo Joonghyuk."

Even though the last one was a little strange, it was a group composition that would definitely not be overlooked anywhere.

But that's what happened to them.

"It might have been a little different if you had been around, but it would be meaningless now."

"What on earth happened?"

"It’s an obvious story. We let our guards down and got caught in an unfortunate event scenario."

The hazy smoke melted into the air.

"We had no idea what losing one’s mask meant. The first to suffer was Kyung Sein. Next was Lee Dansu. Ye Hyunwoo. And even my younger sister."

Killer King's voice became heavier with each word.

"They were no longer able to live as humans."

"What does that mean?"

"I’ll show you."

Killer King took the lead and started walking down the alley as if telling me to follow him.

Why?

The sight of him walking ahead was unfamiliar. In just one month and a week, Killer King seemed to have become someone else I didn't know.

It was then that the event scenario contents arrived.

**<Sub-scenario — The Three Little Pigs>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: B

Clear conditions: Find a 'safe house' to avoid wolves and avoid 'hunting'.

Time limit: 8 hours

Reward: 500 Recycled Coins

Failure: Loss of 'mask' and progress to dehumanization.

As expected, this scenario is about finding a safe home where you can avoid the 'wolves'.

[The area you are located in is Zone 13, District 64.]

[You can proceed with the scenario by selecting the 'Pig' faction.]

[Find a safe home and avoid the 'wolf'.]

[When you are hunted by a wolf, you lose your 'mask'.]

[If a victim occurs in the area, the event scenario in that area ends.]

According to the explanation, this area is never safe until the 'hunt' is completed.

But Killer King spoke in a carefree voice.

"Don’t worry. The wolf has already chosen its prey."

The place where Killer King arrived was an old house located one block away from the guesthouse.

To be exact, it was an old tent that was embarrassing to call a house.

Killer King rang the bell installed in front of the tent.

"Who are you?"

Killer King responded to the voice coming from inside.

"It’s the wolf."

I looked at Killer King in surprise. Next, I heard a system message in my ear.

[A 'wolf' has appeared in that district.]

A frightened gasp was heard from inside the house. The one that stuck its head out was a pale prairie dog.

"Yes, are you here?"

"Yes."

"Preparations are complete."

"Good night."

Inside the tent were several small animals, including prairie dogs. And there was a hippopotamus chained to a chair.

The prairie dog said, pointing to the hippopotamus.

"This is the 'prey' volunteer for this time."

The hippopotamus cried, shaking his shoulders. Killer King slowly approached the hippopotamus.

"Let’s get started."

What do you want to start with?

A ferocious energy flowed from Killer King's right hand as he took off his half-mask.

Feeling ominous, I grabbed Killer King's shoulder.

"Wait."

Killer King's eyes flickered as he looked back at me.

At the same time, someone grabbed my hand. It was little Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Leave it alone."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk was speaking.

"It’s none of your business."

In fact, the prisoners in the tent didn't look like they were happy with my dissuasion.

"I don’t know who you are…"

As soon as the prairie dog opened his mouth, the meerkat beast next to him helped.

"Please don’t get involved."

"Please."

As I looked at the trembling beastmen, I let go of Killer King's shoulder.

Then Killer King spoke.

"Don’t worry. I’ll finish it soon."

With those words, Killer King stood in front of the hippopotamus. The moment the hippopotamus closed his eyes, Killer King let out a long cry into the air. It was a long, lonely howl reminiscent of a real wolf.

[The wolf checks the 'prey'.]

At the same time, Killer King grabbed one of the hippopotamus's arms. With a clunking sound, the hippopotamus's arm was torn off in an instant, and blood splattered out.

Other prisoners grabbed the hippopotamus struggling in pain and quickly began providing first aid.

Killer King put the torn hippopotamus's arm to his side, took out a jingling sack from his chest, and handed it to the prairie dog.

The prairie dog that checked the inside of the bag became happy and muttered.

"Thank you. Thank you."

"This is another week…"

The bag was full of recycled coins.

Killer King looked at the prisoners gathered around the coin bag for a moment, then turned his back and walked out of the tent.

Little Yoo Joonghyuk and I hurriedly followed him.

['Hunt' occurred in Zone 13, District 64.]

[The 'sacrifice' conditions for the district are met.]

A message that comes one step late.

Only then did I understand what Killing King had done.

"This is the core of this scenario. If the wolf hunts the prey, the event conditions are met, and the remaining beasts can survive."

"Is it possible that you have survived this way?"

"Yes."

The reason why the group was able to survive so far in the old wooden villa.

That's because Killer King has been working as a 'wolf' and hunting other preys.

"The other party members chose the pig camp. They planned to form a community with the beastmen and fight against the wolves."

If you think about it, it was natural.

The group read Kim Dokja's story, and above all, he took the side of the 'little people' in Peace Land. So, it was natural to take the pig's side in 'The Three Little Pigs'.

Above all, 'The Three Little Pigs' is a story where the pig wins in the end.

"They failed."

"That’s right. And their mask was taken away."

"And you?"

"I chose the wolf."

"But there was only one choice."

Apparently, all I got was the message 'you can choose the pig side'.

"The wolf camp has hidden options. It is designed so that you can only join the wolf camp by harming other 'beasts'."

In other words, Killer King chose the 'wolf camp' despite harming other prisoners.

"Why did you do that?"

"Because this scenario is a game the pigs can’t win."

I had no idea that Killer King, let alone anyone else, would say such a thing. I was puzzled and disappointed at the same time. Is it because I believed in Killer King that much?

"You don’t know what Zone 13 is."

"I asked you why you did that."

Killer King's eyes, seen through the mask, were slightly widened. He said as if it had been a long time since he had heard anything like that.

"Yes, you can say that. You are indeed Kim Dokja."

"There is a strategy for every scenario. You know that."

Even if you choose the pig camp, there are many ways to attack as long as you use the original story well.

There were even many smart people among the group. Neither Ye Hyunwoo nor Cha Yerin were people to be taken lightly. But why—

"I know what you're thinking. I also know the origin story of this scenario."

"Then why—"

"I guess you checked the other houses on the way here. Did you notice anything strange?"

I looked around.

The street I walked with little Yoo Joonghyuk. The inn we entered when we first warped, the wooden villa where the group lived, and the old tent house. and…

"No way."

Goosebumps slowly appeared.

A cigarette fell on the floor. Killer King took out a second cigarette, lit it, and said.

"There are no brick houses here."

The original content of『The Three Little Pigs』is clear.

This is a story about the youngest pig who built a sturdy 'brick house' in preparation for the wolf and ultimately manages to prevent the wolf from attacking.

"I don't know why, but no matter what I do, I can't find bricks in this area."

However, in Zone 13, there are no 'bricks' to build a 'brick house'.

In other words, it was a place where it was impossible to reproduce the original story.

"So you chose 'Wolf'?"

Killer King nodded.

"Zone 13 is divided into a total of 64 districts. Once hunting activities are met in one district, no more 'event scenarios' will occur in the same district that night."

By 'hunting' different preys, you meet the scenario clear conditions in this area each time.

Killer King has been protecting his companions like that for as long as a month.

"This is the solution I chose."

Killer King, who was staring at the distant sky, looked at me once, then looked at little Yoo Joonghyuk and smiled bitterly.

"If it were Yoo Joonghyuk, it’s a choice he would never have made."

Explosive sounds were heard again amidst the rain. The sound of a tent collapsing and flesh being torn apart. The sound of ominous footsteps was getting closer.

"Wolf Harvest House. I’m coming to collect today’s rewards."

Killer King said, shaking the hippopotamus arm in his hand.

"It doesn’t matter since the hunting in this area is over, but just in case, take him and hide."

I hid behind the tent with little Yoo Joonghyuk.

After a while, harvesters wearing wolf masks appeared one by one. At a glance, they were incarnations with unusual physical strength.

I could tell just by feeling their stories. They were all incarnations that had ruled this area for a very long time and survived.

"Newbie. What’s the harvest today?"

"It is here."

Killer King snapped and threw out the hippopotamus paw.

After checking the front paw, the wolf harvester took a piece of flesh and chewed it lightly.

"It’s a stinky part. Doesn’t this guy even have a proper story?"

"If you got it, get out of here."

The wolf harvester spat on the floor and laughed bitterly.

"You're still rude. Are you overconfident in your abilities?"

"If you want to check, I'll show you."

The wolf harvesters flinched and backed away at the growling voice of Killer King.

One of the harvest officers said with a hardened expression.

"Ever since you took over this Earth, harvests have dropped significantly."

"So?"

"I heard a rumor that you were secretly raising skins."

"It's a rumor."

"I'll know if it's a rumor or not when I check."

With those words, the Wolf Harvester looked towards the wooden villa. Only then did Killer King realize the true intentions of the harvesters and frowned.

"The beastmen of this Earth belong to me."

"The newly arrived leather belongs to the central district. You cannot take it as you wish until it is assigned."

"This is my Earth. I decide that."

I guess he has already collected a lot of stories, so the stories flowing from Killer King's body were unusual. At that level, he is on par with the other top-tier incarnations I met at the Washington Dome.

At that moment, a strange thought occurred to me.

Even though Killer King had reached such a level, why did he have to choose the 'wolf camp'?

If you think about it, the answer was simple.

An entity he cannot dare to confront belongs to the 'wolf camp'.

From behind the wolf harvest stands, an individual that was two heads taller than the other wolves slowly walked out.

[That's funny, young wolf.]

The moment I heard the mantra, the fluff on my forearms stood out.

[You have no decision-making power.]

According to the explanation in 'Ways of Survival', the 'Recycling Center' was clearly a place where incarnations gathered.

But why does someone like that exist here?

[The Constellation 'The Wolf Who Covets Little Red Riding Hood' smiles evilly.]

There was a 'Constellation' in Zone 13.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 726 Episode 28 House (4)

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It was not simply an incarnation of a Constellation with increased synchronization. That was truly the 'incarnation body' of the Constellation himself.

Why is there a guy like that in a place like this?

The nightmare of Washington East emerged again. Memories of being chased by the Constellations along with the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

I came all the way here to avoid them, but I met a Constellation here too.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' looks at you pitifully.]

No. Now is not the time to feel intimidated.

[The story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear' tells you to come to your senses.]

Now that I think about it, since when have stories been able to express their opinions to me?

[The story 'Tenacious Martial Arts Expert' says that anything can be done as long as you are persistent.]

Right. Whoever my opponent was, I also didn't have a very easy story to tell.

Above all, my sponsor is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

As I observed the incarnation of the Constellation while taking deep, light breaths, the composition of the story that made up the incarnation caught my eye.

[Exclusive attribute effect activates!]

Now, I guess my sense of vision has improved, and I was able to read fragments of the other person's story just by paying attention.

「I like Little Red Riding Hood」

「Good at collecting wind」

「I hate brick houses」

…

Fragments of old and sick stories are visible.

[The story that makes up this incarnation has been greatly worn.]

Kim Dokja said:

There is no scenario that cannot be conquered.

[During the event scenario, 'wolves' are not killed by other animals.]

I was reminded of Kim Dokja's 'Revolutionary Scenario'.

For example, the 'wolf' now had the same role as the Executioner of the Demon World.

A position that enters a kind of 'invincible state' during the time when the scenario occurs.

If this scenario were the same, there was also a way to somehow endure the 'night' phase of the wolf and then aim for 'day' when its weaknesses were exposed.

If only it weren't a Constellation.

[Young wolf. Do you want to die?]

At the Constellation's voice, Killer King was taken aback and took a step back.

Even if it is a weakened Constellation, there is an indescribable difference in rank from a normal incarnation.

Killer King probably also knew that fact. That's why he probably chose to survive by protecting his companions instead of attacking the scenario.

Unlike during the Demon World, there are not even 'Revolutionaries' in this scenario.

There is no way to kill that 'wolf', day or night.

Killer King came to that conclusion.

「The incarnation can only be killed through the rules of the 'Event Scenario'.」

In my head, I remembered the contents of 'The Three Little Pigs'.

According to the story, a 'brick house' is needed to deal with the 'wolf'.

However, there are no 'bricks' in this worldview.

[If you had chosen 'Wolf', you would have known. Weak animals are eaten. It is neither sad nor painful. It's just the providence of the story.]

"I gave the hippopotamus's front leg."

[I won't say it twice. Offer one of the 'livestock' you raise. Then, I will leave obediently today.]

Finally, Killer King showed his teeth. Before we knew it, Killer King, who had taken out his bowgun, took a step back and aimed at the wolves.

"Maybe there's another way to just kill you all here."

The leading wolves frowned.

In this 'Event Scenario', the wolf is not killed by 'other animals'.

That meant that they could be killed by other wolves.

Even if there was a Constellation over there, if Killer King had his heart set on it, there was no way he wouldn't be able to catch a wolf or two.

—Kim Dokja. It'll be there.

Killer King’s [Transmission] was heard in my ears.

—Run away with your companions. Since you have packed your luggage in advance, you can leave through the back door.

Killer King smiled as he caught a glimpse of where I was hiding.

—Don’t worry about me. I won't die.

Actually, I don't think Killer King is very similar to Yoo Joonghyuk. It is the same as Kim Dokja, who constantly shouted, "I am Yoo Joonghyuk," and cannot become Yoo Joonghyuk.

The reason I'm shaking now is probably because I read 'Ways of Survival' right before I came here.

「"I will not die."」

That's what Yoo Joonghyuk of 'Ways of Survival' always said right before he died.

I won't die.

Yoo Joonghyuk always left those words behind when he died.

To Yoo Joonghyuk himself, those words must have been true. Because he is a Regressor who never dies.

But are those words true for those left behind after his death?

[Kill him.]

At the same time as the Constellation gave an order, three wolves rushed towards Killer King.

In an instant, the wolf's claws rushed in, aiming at Killer King's front, back, left and right sides.

[The story fragment 'Heir of the Black Coat' begins its storytelling!]

When did he collect such story fragments?

Killer King's brilliant coat fluttering gesture made his claws snap off cleanly.

A fierce lion's roar erupted from the corner of Killer King's mouth with a heartless smile.

[Fragment of the story 'A person who resembles the voice of the Supreme King' shouts loudly!]

I thought he might be able to imitate regression, but of course I didn't have the courage to test that.

Killer King, who was hit on the back of the head, gritted his teeth and let out a loud noise.

—Kim Dokja! hurry!

It is actions, not words, that determine a person's essence. Sincere actions remain as stories, and they are talked about and become stories.

[The story 'The Lone Savior' begins its storytelling.]

The legend accumulated by Killer King was shining brightly.

It is not the same as Yoo Joonghyuk's, but it is no less noble.

That narrative dominated Killer King. It was leading him to his death.

"If you leave him like that, he will die."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk was right.

If we leave him like this, Killer King will die.

Just like Sergeant Jung Moonho in Seoul Station and Jung Jaewoo in the Theater Dungeon.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Let me ask you a favor."

"Ask?"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at me. Facing his suspicious eyes, I searched for items in the 'Dokkaebi Bag'.

This worldview is a place where the use of 'Skills' and 'Stigmata' is prohibited. The effect of the item is also halved and it cannot perform as well as it should.

In other words, no matter what I buy from the 'Dokkaebi Bag', there is no way to kill that 'Wolf Constellation'.

However, it may be possible if it takes some time.

[1,000 coins were consumed in the 'Dokkaebi Bag'.]

[The item 'Red Riding Hood (Replica)' has been acquired.]

I placed the items purchased through the 'Dokkaebi Bag' on little Yoo Joonghyuk's head.

[The item's effect increases the target's attention!]

Little Yoo Joonghyuk was startled and struggled.

The effect of this item is simple.

The wearer becomes a little cuter, more appetizing, and attracts attention.

Although the effect of the item is halved here, this should be enough for now.

"What are you doing—"

The moment little Yoo Joonghyuk, who had barely peeked his head out of the hood, stood up, the gaze of the wolf Constellation turned towards him.

[The Constellation 'The Wolf Who Loves Little Red Riding Hood' finds prey!]

If that wolf was a normal Constellation, it wouldn't have fallen into this trap.

But there was something different about him.

I was confident because I had already met several other Constellations.

An unstable status for a Constellation.

The story contained in its incarnation was unbalanced, and its 'character' was not perfect.

A rag-like incarnation made up of old story fragments that have not been properly repaired for a long time.

Crucially, 'The Three Little Pigs' was not the only story that constituted the incarnation of the wolf.

[The story 'The Wolf Who Covets Little Red Riding Hood' begins its storytelling.]

Constellations that have lived for a long time have difficulty distinguishing between their own will and the will of the story.

As the story began its storytelling, the instinct of the guy who had been consumed by the story awakened.

[Little Red Riding Hood.]

Its bright red, bloodshot eyes began to shine, and it started running toward little Yoo Joonghyuk, wagging its tail like a mad dog.

I nodded solemnly towards little Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Let’s run."

"You—"

"If you don’t run fast, you will die."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk gritted his teeth and looked back at me and said.

"I will definitely kill you, Kim Dokja."

Almost at the same time, I ducked for cover.

With the fierce wind blowing, Yoo Joonghyuk and the new form of the wolf Constellation disappeared at the same time.

Coo coo coo coo coo.

When I looked up outside the cover, I saw little Yoo Joonghyuk running away and a wolf Constellation chasing after him.

It was a dangerous sight, as if he was about to be caught, but Yoo Joonghyuk will be fine. I don't know if the guy's stamina was as low as before, but Yoo Joonghyuk's stamina had recovered quite a bit now.

I saw him sitting on my shoulder, secretly taking out an elixir from his pocket, and consuming it with my own eyes.

He eats eight meals a day, so he should have fully recovered by now.

That's not all.

[The effect of the item 'White Rat Mask' is activated!]

['Animal Mask' does not receive the 'performance reduction effect' of the corresponding world view.]

Is it because it is a 'Zodiac' worldview?

'Mask' is the only item here that maintains its original performance.

If the effect of 'Rat Mask', which won first place in the 'Zodiac Race', is that there will be no chance of getting caught for a while.

"You guys."

Meanwhile, Killer King, who had defeated all the other wolves, turned to look at me.

Indeed, Killer King is the Second Apostle.

Is it possible to subdue a wolf that is not a Constellation without using skills or stigmata?

Killer King wiped away his bloody nose and said, glaring in this direction.

"Do you know what you did?"

"I know."

"The southern part of Zone 13 is the territory of the 'wolves'. Now you—"

"I am the enemy of the wolves."

Killer King looked at me as if he was dumbfounded and muttered.

"Have you really become Kim Dokja?"

We started collecting items and story fragments from the fallen wolves.

Some of the story fragments were useful and some were trash.

Not all stories are recycled when they enter the 'Recycling Center'.

"It’s not too late. If you’re going to leave, now is your only chance."

Killer King, who was picking up items, stood up and said.

"Go to another Zodiac Area. You haven't lost your mask yet, so there must be a way to escape. I will take care of the rest of the group somehow."

"I don't like it."

"Kim Dokja."

At first glance, a scar was revealed on the back of Killer King's hand. It was a wound that had never appeared before.

"This is only the eighth scenario. Do you know how many of the characters we know died on the way to here?"

"…"

"You don't necessarily need everyone to see the ending."

What Killer King said was right.

Not all characters are needed for the ending of this world.

"I and my companions have now accepted it. This world is not the 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' we used to know."

No one knows how many more people will die on the journey to the end.

Some people will live and some people will die. Some will be forgotten and others will be remembered.

I also know Killer King knew.

This story will not end with a beautiful ending like a fairy tale.

"I need you to get the ending I want."

"It's typical of Kim Dokja to be unreasonable. Are you really going to take on that role? I'm sure you know what that means."

I quietly looked into Killer King's eyes. Now I had no choice but to admit it. That person really read 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' a hundred times.

He really knows what I'm thinking.

I opened my mouth, feeling inexplicably comforted by that fact.

"I know."

"Even though you know that—"

"You seem to be mistaken, but the reason you are needed is because you are so useful."

No matter what I do, I cannot become 'Kim Dokja, the Demon King of Salvation'.

Just as Killer King cannot become 'Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk' no matter what he does.

Killer King looked at me with blank eyes for a moment, then smiled brightly.

"I see. Somebody needs help…"

"Yeah."

Killer King's eyebrows twitched.

"Is there some kind of solution? As of now, even if you and I work together, we can't catch that wolf."

"In theory, yes. But isn't there something strange about this scenario?"

"Strange?"

"The name is 'The Three Little Pigs', but the structure of the scenario is very similar to a scenario we know. The wolf's position and, of course, the fact that the scenario begins at 'night'."

A game to catch a 'werewolf' that kills people by biting them every night.

We already know a 'scenario' that is very similar to that.

"Have you ever wondered why this center is called 'Recycling Center'?"

Recycle. It literally means to reuse something that has been used. Killer King, who was thinking about something in response to my question, took a deep breath and muttered.

"No way…"

I don't know who the director of this 'Recycling Center' is or for what purpose this stage was designed. But.

"If what I think is right…"

I swept the dirt off the floor and gauged the flow of the surrounding stories.

Since when did it start?

One by one, the group approached behind Killer King.

Kyung Sein, Dansu ahjussi, Ye Hyunwoo. And even Cha Yerin.

I thought as I looked at them.

Only the eighth scenario.

As Killer King said, many readers have died. Readers died again and again, as if the world was hostile to them.

"We are the people in the world who can tell this story better than anyone else."

Nevertheless, 'Kim Dokja' still did not die.

"Let's start the 'Revolutionary Game' now."

From now on, it is Kim Dokja's time.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 727 Episode 28 House (5)

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"From now on, we will become 'little pigs'."

[Someone declared 'Little Pig'!]

I smiled bitterly as I looked at the scenario message blinking in the air. Again, this scenario is similar to the Demon World's 'Revolutionary Game'.

[Some Constellations from the Chinese Zodiac are interested in this declaration.]

I checked the indirect messages floating in the air and summarized the facts I learned after entering this 'center'.

「One, incidents at this 'Recycling Center' are not reported outside of the center.」

This was what was described in the 'Ways of Survival'. Originally, the 'Recycling Center' was a place where incarnations of small and medium-sized nebulae strengthened their power to fight against the 'Giant Nebulae'. Naturally, the Constellations of the 'Giant Nebulae' cannot know what is happening here.

「Two, the only ones who have jurisdiction over events within this 'Recycling Center' are the Constellations related to the 'Recycling Center'.」

This is also an extension of the first fact.

In other words, only the zodiac or animal Constellations can observe the affairs of this '13th Zone'.

[The Constellation 'The First Pig to Die' is looking forward to your performance.]

[The Constellation 'The Nail-Eating Rat' pays attention to your judgment.]

This at least lowered the possibility that <Asgard>, <Olympus>, and other large nebulae that had been bothering me would directly intervene in the situation.

The task at hand now is to recreate「The Three Little Pigs」.

That's the only way to deal with the wolf, which isn't invincible only at night.

I asked, looking around at my companions.

"First of all, could you please tell me what kind of animal each of you became?"

"I… as you can see, I'm a squirrel."

"I'm a turtle."

Kyung Sein is a squirrel. Dansu ahjussi is a turtle.

Ye Hyunwoo, who was pursing his lips in annoyance, looks like a panda, and lastly, Cha Yerin—

"Sna (달)."

Cha Yerin, who had spoken up to that point, was unable to continue speaking for a long time. Instead, it was Killer King who answered again.

"She's a snail (달팽)."

Cha Yerin slowly lowered her head, perhaps because she was embarrassed that she had become a snail.

Now that I think about it, all the people gathered here have become animals that have nothing to do with the 'Zodiac'. Is it a coincidence?

"Are there any 'pigs' by any chance?"

Now that I think about it, while coming here, I have never once encountered any animals belonging to the Chinese zodiac. Although I saw similar animals, most of them were subtypes or variants.

"There can’t be a pig. This is Zone 13. You would know what that means."

It was only after hearing Killer King's answer that I became convinced of the meaning behind the name of this place.

Zone 13.

All of the incarnations here did not enter the Chinese zodiac.

"Now that I think about it, what kind of animal are you?"

"I didn’t choose an animal."

"I know you chose to wear a no-animal mask. But even if you chose a no-face mask, you end up using an animal mask."

You end up wearing an animal mask?

"That mask is designed to understand the user’s story and change into the most appropriate animal mask. But you—"

I looked at my reflection in the window of a nearby building. My mask was still a maskless mask.

A face where no animal shape is visible.

I looked at the smooth surface of the mask for a moment and then turned around.

"It’s okay. It’s not important right now. The only time Yoo Joonghyuk can earn is about 20 minutes at most."

Currently, 'The Wolf Who Loves Little Red Riding Hood' is chasing after Yoo Joonghyuk, a kid wearing a hood.

No matter how much of a Constellation in love with stories he is, he will come to his senses in about 20 minutes.

Before Yoo Joonghyuk, who became Little Red Riding Hood, is eaten by the wolf, we must somehow establish an operation.

"The operation is simple. To recreate 'The Three Little Pigs'."

"I would have said that was impossible."

Killer King frowned and walked away.

"It wasn’t just fools who chose the 'pig camp'. We also tried to do something similar to you at first."

"What exactly did you do?"

"I was planning on hiding in the house and killing him with a brick, just like the original story."

"Yes?"

I thought I had heard something wrong.

"Do you know what The Three Little Pigs is about?"

Killer King nodded confidently and answered.

"It’s a story about the three little pigs killing a wolf with a brick."

In what universe is this「The Three Little Pigs」?

If you think about it broadly, it was difficult to see that the story was completely wrong, but in any case, it seemed clear that Killer King did not know the exact original story.

When I looked at the other party members, it was Kyung Sein who answered first.

"Actually, I haven’t read many fairy tales."

Even if it's a famous story, at least one person may not know it.

I turned to Ye Hyunwoo. Of course the smart 7th apostle would know this.

Ye Hyunwoo asked back, scratching his cheek in annoyance.

"Um, like an old-fashioned version of Baby Shark?"

Come to think of it,『The Three Little Pigs』is already an old story.

It's natural that friends these days don't know.

But what about Dansu ahjussi?

"That’s because my Jiyoon doesn’t like fairy tales…"

"..."

"It’s been so long since I read anything. Heh heh. Heh heh."

I looked at Literature Girl 64 Cha Yerin, my last hope. Then she, Cha Yerin, secretly avoided my eyes.

"You really don’t know? No?"

"My younger sister only read complete world literature and Korean novels."

I was devastated.

Does this mean that none of them know 'The Three Little Pigs'?

I remembered hearing somewhere that the average amount of reading per year for Koreans was 1.5 books.

Still, there are people among them who have read 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' a hundred times, so does it make sense that they do not know famous fairy tales such as 'The Three Little Pigs'?

Wait a minute, when I thought about it, wouldn't reading 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' 100 times mean that they were deprived of the opportunity to read other books?

"So... you planned along well and attacked?"

In response to my question, the panda who had read 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' fifty times nodded confidently.

"To be exact, we couldn’t find bricks, so we fought with stones. It was a brilliant plan aimed at staging it."

"So the staging occurred?"

"That…"

The panda became sullen. The wolf, who had read the 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' a hundred times, added, shaking his head.

"So everyone lost their masks. As expected, if I hadn't chosen the 'wolf camp' with my genius judgment, everyone would have been wiped out."

It seems that Killer King did not participate in the operation, but hid alone and chose the 'wolf camp'.

"There was no other way. In a world without bricks, there is no way to fight against them. As you can see, the leader of the wolves is a Constellation."

"It's a half-formed Constellation. There is a way to kill it."

"You're probably trying to use 'staging' too, right?"

I nodded.

Although my companions failed, 'staging' is always activated in scenarios with stories as a motif. That's for sure.

"But there are no bricks in this worldview."

I know.

In this world, there are no houses made of bricks and no walls made of bricks.

It was as if someone had deliberately cut out the concept of 'brick' from this world.

It's probably the wolves' doing.

They destroyed all the bricks in Zone 13 to prevent this scenario from proceeding normally.

But that didn't mean there wasn't a way to get bricks.

"Let's buy it."

I called 'Dokkaebi Bag' in my head. The 'Dokkaebi Bag' can also be used here. Even if you go to Moro, you only have to go to Seoul.

[The 'brick' item cannot be purchased in this world.]

That's how it comes out.

I then opened an 'exchange'.

Fortunately, there were bricks at the exchange. A lot of that too.

| Old Brick — 50,000 C |
|---|

50,000 coins each?

[A very small number of Constellations are chuckling at you.]

I understand roughly how things work. It's definitely the work of the Constellations who sell items through gaps in the scenario like this.

It's not that I couldn't buy it if I wanted to, but I didn't want to enrich the merchants like this.

Even just buying that doesn't mean you can build a brick house.

Kyung Sein asked in a nervous voice.

"What should I do? Should I dig up any stone?"

"Bricks are made of clay, not stone."

"Really? Really? How do you know?"

How do I know? It's a story that also appears in 'Ways of Survival'.

"All you have to do is mix sand or petrified clay and heat it at a high temperature of over 1,100 degrees. This is the method of making 'clay bricks' as we know them."

"Were you originally a bricklayer?"

Again, this is an explanation that also appears in 'Ways of Survival'.

I don't know why that was even explained, but there was an explanation anyway.

"You said that the method is sand and petrification, right? If you can somehow get it—"

"It’s impossible to build it in time. Plus, you have to build a house."

It was a strange scenario to begin with.

With wolves coming right around the corner, does it make sense to build a 'brick house' by making bricks that will take a year to make?

Was this scenario really designed to be cleared that way?

"There was no 'Revolutionary' in the revolutionary scenario."

It was Killer King who said those words.

'And there are no 'brick houses' here."

I looked at Killer King. Then Killer King also looked at me.

"Perhaps."

"If I’m right."

I hate to admit it, but we were thinking the same thing.

"This scenario resembles the 'revolutionary scenario'."

There is a 'brick house' in this world.

"I think I found a solution."

However, no one admits that it is a 'brick house'.

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After a while, we arrived at the hotel 'Fox and Crane'.

As soon as I kicked in the door, a startled crane jumped out screaming.

"What’s happening all of a sudden?"

"I’m going to stay here for a day."

"I’m sorry, but there are no rooms available right now, so please leave."

I ignored the crane owner's words and looked around the inside of the inn.

Looking around the inside, it was an ordinary wooden building.

"It’s an ordinary wooden building."

Killer King said after returning from examining the outside wall of the inn.

"The interior and exterior walls are quite solid, but they don’t look like they were made of any other materials. At least that’s what the naked eye sees."

A crane with a pale complexion shouted.

"I don’t know what you’re thinking, but please go away. I don’t want to get involved anymore!"

"The house is very sturdy. There isn’t a single scratch, and it looks like it’s quite old."

"Because we worked hard to build that—"

"Who built this?"

At my question, the crane gasped and took a deep breath.

"I can’t tell you."

"This is a wooden building, right?"

"Of course it’s a wooden building!"

"I guess so."

I said, lightly digging my ear.

"Even the building says so."

[Fragment of the story 'The House That Is Not a Brick House' continues its storytelling.]

I don't know what kind of trick was used, but this building had 'fragments of stories' embedded in it.

To be exact, it was only stuck in this building in the entire area.

[Fragment of the story 'The House That Is Not a Brick House' continues its storytelling.]

At first, I had no idea where the sound was coming from, but I was convinced only after passing by the inn a few times.

"It is not a brick house."

There’s something strange about this inn.

"It’s strange. Anyone can see that it is not a brick house, but you are saying that it is not a brick house."

"What?"

"It means that a person who is not a liar does not have to say that he is not a liar."

"…"

"What on earth are you hiding?"

"Now, you guys don’t know anything. Don’t get involved in this scenario!"

I slowly reached out to the inner wall of the house. Killer King and his companions subdued the owner who ran towards me while shouting.

As I closed my eyes, I immediately heard the birth of a story within the wall.

[Fragment of the story 'The House That Is Not a Brick House' begins to tremble.]

I slowly grabbed the fragment of the story stuck on the wall. It would be a good idea to just pull it out like this, but there was something I wanted to test.

[The sub-skill 'Sentence Enhancement' is activated!]

[You can enter your actions.]

[The action you entered will be 'reinforced'.]

As expected, [Sentence Enhancement] can now be used again.

「Sentence Enhancement is a skill that is activated and even ignored scenario restrictions.」

I always used this skill only to strengthen [Incite].

However, wouldn’t it be possible to use this skill a little differently?

[Fragment of the story 'The House That Is Not a Brick House' stops its storytelling.]

For example, slightly modifying the 'story' that has already been written.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 728 Episode 28 House (6)

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Ji Eunyu once said,

"Writer, your sentences are very neat. There is no unnecessary information."

When I first heard that, I didn't think it was a compliment.

"I just don’t have confidence in the sentences I went with."

I am a writer who neither knows how to write elegant descriptions nor write complex sentences.

Nevertheless, Ji Eunyu praised my half-baked sentences for my eloquent speaking skills.

"No, that’s not true. How difficult it is to choose and use only the words you need. There are times when you can make a better sentence by just leaving out a few unnecessary words or particles, but it’s harder than you think."

Ji Eunyu said.

Take it out.

Even if you think you need it, take it out. Think about it and then take it out. Look again and take it out. Anyway, take it out.

Good sentences are built on such solid margins.

Those are really good words.

However, anyone who has ever written anything will know that leaving something out is not that easy.

It is not easy to remove even a single particle, much less a comma.

This is probably because it involves erasing something that took time to write.

The blank space created by erasing the sentence certainly feels different from the original blank space.

It feels like the soul of a sentence that has disappeared above the margins is alive and hovering around.

As a result, I sometimes had that thought while deleting sentences.

It's not that I don't want to erase the sentence, but maybe the sentence is telling me not to erase it.

Like now, so to speak.

[Story fragment 'The House That is Not a Brick House' refuses your touch!]

The moment I touched the fragment of the story, sparks flew out. A heart-stopping shock hit my chest, and I even drooled like someone who had been electrocuted.

"No, what are you thinking!"

"Sparks strike! Stop!"

Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi rushed in and helped me up.

But I couldn't stop. No matter how much I thought about it, this was the only way.

"I think I found a brick."

"Yes? Really?"

The explosion that was echoing in the distance was getting closer. 'Little Red Riding Hood' ran towards us, destroying every building we saw.

And Yoo Joonghyuk, Little Red Riding Hood, was running dangerously in front of us.

"Kim Dokja—!"

There is no time anymore.

I once again grabbed the fragment of the story.

The story fragment was speaking.

「I am not a brick house.」

I realize once again how much difficulty Ji Eunyu has been through all this time.

It is not easy to change what has already been written. What is written is read, and what is read is remembered by those who read it. Memories soon become the basis of reality.

Therefore, changing the story means changing reality.

Tsutsutsutsu.

I had no idea that it would be this difficult to fix just one fragment of a story.

Sparks flew every time the fragment of the story in my hand fluttered.

[Your 'fourth story' has fully blossomed.]

It was then that the message occurred to me.

[The story 'The One Who Rewrites Fate' begins its storytelling.]

「The One Who Rewrites Fate.」

This was the new story I got with 'The Demon King of Salvation'.

[Your understanding of the story 'The One Who Rewrites Fate' is low.]

[You will have 'very little' resistance to probability aftermaths.]

Surprisingly, the effect of this story is a certain level of immunity to 'probability aftermaths'.

When the spark of the story fragment became endurable, [Sentence Enhancement] shone once again.

[Sub-skill 'Sentence Enhancement' is activated.]

[Receives the effect of the story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear'.]

[The trait of 'Story Repair' will bloom in you!]

The struggles of the story fragments were gradually calming down.

[The target is a 'low-level story fragment'.]

[Would you like to edit this 'story fragment'?]

As I slowly touched the fragments of the story, I could clearly feel the sentences written on the story. From the time this story was first created until now, the years that have accumulated on the sentence were vividly conveyed.

「I am not a brick house.」

I looked back at the inn 'The Crane and the Fox' while holding the story tightly. I thought it was strange from the beginning.

Killer King and others also said this. This house is not a brick house, perhaps because the story says so.

But at least to me,

[The 'story fragment' did not convince you.]

This house was a 'brick house'.

The fragment of the story was trembling.

I held on to the fragment of the story and placed my hand on the sentence that came to mind.

Kim Dokja said: There is no scenario that cannot be conquered.

Ways of Survival said. It is said that this world is made up of 'stories'.

I persuade it while holding on tightly to the story. Or [incite].

"You."

Unravel the history accumulated in story fragment. Remove the words written on the fragment one by one. Take out 'n', take out 'o'. Remove spaces between words.

By subtracting, subtracting, and subtracting again, we finally create one neat sentence.

It brings out the original story fragment of a story that has been stained over a long period of time.

"You're a brick house."

The next moment, the story fragment began to melt together with a bright light.

A brightly shining gemstone of story appeared from the melted debris.

「I am a brick house.」

The fragment said.

「I am a brick house.」

I nodded. Then, I quietly inserted the fragment of the story into the wall of the house.

[Story fragment 'The Brick House' begins its storytelling.]

This world is made up of stories. And the story is made up of fragments of the story.

The smallest particle that changes the world.

The moment that particle hit the wall, reality changed.

Tsutsutsutsu.

The interior of the inn, which was finished with wood, was rippling like waves. The old wood was replaced with hard, dense orange-colored bricks.

My companions opened their mouths.

Cha Yerin closed her eyes as if listening to the story fragment, and Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu touched various parts of the brick house as if they were curious.

"It's a brick house! It's a brick house, really!"

"How could this—"

Killer King nodded as if he knew that would happen. Ye Hyunwoo, who was surprised, looked back at me as if asking what I did.

"The Recycling Center is a world made of old stories."

The background of this event scenario is 'The Three Little Pigs'.

In order for this story fragment to be recreated, a 'brick house' is necessary.

But there are no bricks in this world.

"Then, of course, 'bricks' are also made of stories."

What we needed to find in the first place was not a real 'brick' but the story of a 'brick'.

"We have to close the door!"

A pack of wolves came right in front of us. But Yoo Joonghyuk hadn’t come in yet.

I shouted as loud as I could as I closed the door to the brick house.

"Yoo Joonghyuk! Chimney!"

Through the closing door, I saw little Yoo Joonghyuk nodding.

The sound of something hitting one after another was heard from beyond the closed brick house. Then, I heard something like a flying squirrel running across the roof.

A moment later, little Yoo Joonghyuk, covered in what looked like black soot, jumped out of the fireplace under the chimney.

"Kim Dokja—!"

I left Yoo Joonghyuk's arrival behind and shouted to my companions.

"Boil water in the furnace! Quick!"

『The Three Little Pigs』 started now.

Then, water began to boil under the chimney stove.

[The constellation 'Rat Eating Nails' looks forward to what will happen next.]

[The constellation 'Primordial Cow,' likes it as it is the first reenactment he has seen in a long time.]

[The constellation 'The First Pig To Die' says he is excited for the first time in a long time.]

A strong wind was blowing outside. The wolves are probably forcing air into their lungs with all their might.

[Like this house—!]

In the original work, 『The Three Little Pigs』, the wolves blow down the house the little pigs built with their breath.

The first pig's house made of straw and the second pig's house made of wood are destroyed by the wolf's breath.

However, the 'youngest pig's' house, built of bricks, is different.

Coo coo coo coo!

A strong wind once struck the house. Two, three, four times.

The wind's speed was quite strong, so the brick house shook precariously.

Every time that happened, I whispered to the story fragment.

"You are a brick house."

「I am a brick house.」

[Story fragment the 'brick house' becomes even stronger.]

[The constellation 'The Wolf Who Loves Little Red Riding Hood' is astonished!]

I could feel the wolves' agitation beyond the wall.

[How did you build a 'brick house'?]

Now they too are realizing that something is wrong.

[No way… I'm sure I couldn't find that 'story'.]

I expected it.

Obviously, in a normal scenario, fragments of the 'Brick House' story would not be obtained in this way.

What I used was a kind of shortcut.

It was the same principle as Kim Dokja's impersonation of a revolutionary in 'Revolutionary Game'.

Strictly speaking, it is a 'house that is not a brick house' transformed into a 'brick house'.

[Very few constellations ask if that was possible.]

[A constellation that has not yet revealed its modifier nods to your solution.]

A constellation whose modifier is not disclosed.

As far as I know, the only one who has ever sent a message in that form is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

However, the 'Demon King of Salvation' is currently not in a state to send indirect messages.

So who is the owner of that message?

Perhaps the owner of that message is also like the 'Demon King of Salvation'…

Doo doo doo doo.

I heard something jumping on the brick roof. As expected, the wolf incarnations began to move.

'Little Red Riding Hood’s wolf' shouted.

[Stop, you idiots! This means don’t move carelessly!]

Still, the wolves did not stop.

[Review the reproduction requirements for stage productions in your region.]

In order for a story to be 'staged', several 'conditions' related to the stage, including the 'story', must be met.

For example, in order to reproduce 『Spring of the Demon World』 of <Kim Dokja Company>, key members of <Kim Dokja Company>, including Kim Dokja, and the 'chariot' of Surya, a narrative-grade constellation, are needed.

So what about the case of 『The Three Little Pigs』?

[Story fragment 'Leader of the Wolves' begins its storytelling.]

First, the villain of the story, 'Wolf'.

[Story fragment 'The Brick House' begins its storytelling.]

And the 'brick house', the core material of the story.

The last thing we need is the 'youngest pig', the main character of the story.

But unfortunately, there was no 'youngest pig' here.

[Fragment of the story, 'The Last Born' begins its storytelling.]

Instead, here is me, the 'youngest' Kim Dokja.

[Story fragment 'The Man Who Eats Eight Meals In One Day' begins its storytelling.]

And although the reason is unknown, there was a guy who had fragments of a story that could replace the 'pig' story.

The moment when Yoo Joonghyuk, a frowning little boy, was about to board the flag.

[Representation requirements for staging were incompletely met.]

[The story 'The Three Little Pigs' begins its storytelling.]

「Staging has begun.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 729 Episode 28 House (7)

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I reflexively looked back.

"Tie up Killer King. Quick!"

Wolves aren't just outside your home. There are wolves in this house too.

"Kim Dokja. I don’t give in to 'staging'."

Killer King, wearing a black wolf mask, spoke confidently.

Of course I know he won't attack us. I believe in him too.

"I know."

However, I believe in 'stories' more.

"This is to protect you. Please believe me."

Killer King looked at me for a moment and then nodded his head.

"I believe you, Kim Dokja."

Even during this time, one concept was clear: He was just an incarnation and can be affected by the story.

Kyung Sein moved quickly like a flying squirrel and tied Killer King tightly to a chair, and Cha Yerin spread snail slime on him. Ye Hyunwoo, moving leisurely, tied the bamboo stem around Killer King's legs as if twisting a rope.

I never told them to do something like that.

Ye Hyunwoo asked Killer King, who frowned.

"Are you hurt?"

"A little."

"Okay."

The moment Killer King was about all tied up, sparks began to strike in the air.

Tsutsutsutsu.

Old stories are remembered by the Constellations.

Constellations look back on their memories, reminisce, and sometimes even add probability for reenactment, and enjoy stories in their own way.

[The Constellations from the zodiac who remember the legend are happy.]

[The story 'The Three Little Pigs' accelerates its storytelling.]

The strength of the story fragment 'Brick House' has become stronger. That wasn't all. The eyes of the wolves that were blowing deathly sounds outside the window were changing.

[You—]

The embarrassed wolf Constellation issued an order.

[Stop! Stop! Stop right now!]

The wolf incarnations jumped onto the roof of the brick house one by one, paying no heed to the Constellation's order.

The wolves that were blowing, and the wolves that were headbutting the brick house, all started jumping on the roof as if they were possessed.

Even the tightly bound Killer King trembled, his eyes turning red.

This was the power of stories.

"Kwaaaaaaaa!"

The wolf incarnations that came through the chimney fell into the boiling water and screamed. Under normal circumstances, it would have been impossible to get rid of them with just boiling water. If you've reached the eighth scenario, the incarnations will also have a certain level of pain tolerance.

However, under the influence of this「staging」, such introspection was useless.

Their core attribute now is 'wolves', and the water in the furnace will inflict pain on the 'wolves' equivalent to Uriel's [Hell Burning].

Even if you ask why something like that happens, there is no answer.

Because this is just that kind of story.

The story of a little pig who built a brick house and won over the wolves.

The wolf incarnations that entered the chimney started convulsing and screaming as soon as their feet touched the water. Some crawled out of the chimney passage with their feet melting in the steam, while others bounced like popcorn.

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' cheers!]

[The Constellation 'The Chicken That Crows First' makes an interested cry.]

[The Constellation 'The Sacrificial Lamb of God' says that the story of the pig is long overdue.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' yawns.]

And there were Constellations that enjoyed observing their suffering.

[The Constellation 'The Pig Who Built the Brick House' nods.]

And the protagonists of the「stage」were us.

The poor 'Three Little Pigs'.

Although the original story includes the sacrifice of the 'first pig' who built a house with straw and the 'second pig' who built a house with wood, it was omitted in this stage.

Nevertheless, no Constellation raised an issue.

[The Constellations from the Chinese zodiac giggle, saying it has been a while since they heard this story.]

Because this is a story that everyone already knows.

Obvious sacrifice and obvious death give no inspiration to the Constellations.

What they are curious about is not the ordeal of the little pigs.

'So what happens next?'

Only how exhilaratingly can someone take revenge. And how miserably the Constellation that was in the position of a predator fell.

[Some Constellations are looking forward to your 'narrative reenactment'.]

[8,000 recycled coins were sponsored.]

[A few Constellations want you to torture the wolves even more cruelly.]

[A very small number of Constellations suggest what it would be like to change the furnace water to hydrochloric acid.]

Now we were agents of that revenge. People who reproduce old stories on behalf of the Constellations and reinterpret stories on behalf of the Constellations.

Thus, the incarnations that receive coins and live.

[5,000 coins were sponsored.]

This was the world that Kim Dokja had lived in all along.

Kyung Sein grabbed my sleeve.

"If."

A faint tremor passed through my sleeves.

"If we all chose the wolf camp… what would have happened?"

There was no need to ask.

"Everyone would probably be dead."

[3,000 recycled coins were sponsored.]

The story was successfully recreated, and the wolf incarnations that threatened us were exterminated.

Did we make the right choice? Did we successfully clear the 'Event Scenario'?

[The 'Recycling Center Director' pays attention to your choice.]

So why is the center still waiting for my 'choice'?

「Is there still something left to 'choose' in this story?」

As I slowly turned my head, I noticed other prisoners who were unable to evacuate and remained inside the inn.

Even though the wolves that had been harassing them were suffering miserably, their expressions did not look happy. There were also some who were distorted or sad.

「This is a place where animals that do not belong to the zodiac live together.」

And the guys watching this story from the sky right now were all from the 'zodiac'.

"Dokja-ssi. Killer King—"

Killer King's eyes were red and his breathing was becoming rough. The rope tying Killer King also became tense as if it might break.

The story was encroaching on Killer King.

[Very few Constellations wonder why there is a 'wolf' inside the brick house.]

[A very small number of Constellations order to kill the 'wolf' inside the brick house.]

"Tie it stronger! You just have to hold on a little longer!"

"Shall we turn on the drink?"

"Do it yourself!"

Killer King’s screams were heard. But screaming is better than dying.

[Some Constellations are puzzled by your judgment.]

[Very few Constellations say that if you eliminate all wolves, you will receive a greater reward.]

Bigger rewards. Their Words sounded almost convincing.

No one in the group wanted to sacrifice Killer King.

He chose the wolf camp himself and protected his party for a month.

Are we going to kill him just so we can finish one「staging」?

"Hey, wolf!"

I shouted to the wolf Constellation beyond the wall, 'The Wolf Who Likes Little Red Riding Hood'.

"Just do it in moderation. It’s obvious what will happen if the「staging」continues like this."

'The Wolf Who Likes Little Red Riding Hood' hasn't climbed onto the roof yet.

Perhaps this is because this「staging」is imperfect, and the Constellation can overcome the influence of the staging to some extent by his own will.

Nevertheless, if time passed like this, the ending of the story was obvious.

[The Constellations from the Chinese zodiac want you to put an end to the 'wolf'.]

But will Killer King be able to hold out until then?

I took a deep breath, organized my thoughts, and continued speaking.

"I know. It’s probably unfair to you too. You’re not even a part of the story. So let’s stop."

『The Three Little Pigs』was an old story.

Now there is no wolf that tried to eat the pig, nor is there the youngest pig that fought bravely against the wolf.

All that remains are the Constellations in the sky, twinkling calmly, chewing, biting, and tasting old stories.

[The Constellations of the Zodiac look at 'The Wolf Who Loves Little Red Riding Hood'.]

Outside the dimly lit window, I could see the incarnation body of the wolf trembling.

Clearly, the 'wolf' was the villain in『The Three Little Pigs』. But even in this story called the <Star Stream>, are wolves still the villains?

What is that predator afraid of that makes it tremble like that?

[The Constellation 'The First Pig to Die' tilts its head towards you.]

[A few Zodiac Signs are puzzled by your choice.]

[A very small number of Constellations ask whether you are now supporting wolves.]

[Some Constellations ask the wolf whether he feels sorry for the dead incarnations.]

Right. Clearly, the wolf of Zone 13 was a villain. However, the animals here did not seem to be very afraid of the wolves.

Rather, they were worried about the wolf's behavior.

In particular, the crane owner looked like he was going to collapse at any moment.

"Please, please stop. That wolf cannot die. An even bigger tragedy will occur."

What on earth are these animals afraid of?

[The Constellation 'The Wolf Who Likes Little Red Riding Hood' roars.]

The blood vessels around his eyes burst and the wolf lost his temper and his body hit against the brick house. A dull impact sound rang out.

Coo coo coo coo.

The wind blowing out from the wolf created a strong gust and shook the brick house. Once again, his huge body crashed into the brick house.

Again and again, it was not the brick house that was broken, but the body of the guy.

The crane owner and the other beastmen screamed.

"No! I would rather offer meat. Please, please!"

"Isn’t this the wolf that was harassing you?"

The owner of the crane opened his eyes wide at my words and said.

"Yeah, it might seem that way. But you don’t really know how this district works. His death doesn’t change anything. This story—"

For a moment, I felt like I knew something.

It wasn't the wolves they were afraid of.

Rather, they are beings that are 'far above' those 'wolves'.

[Some Constellations belonging to the nebula <Zodiac> are happy.]

The wolf Constellation was dying. The incarnation was a mess, and most of the stories it had were destroyed.

Now, the wolf barely had any memories of the 'Three Little Pigs'.

Even his modifier has nothing to do with 'little pigs'.

Nevertheless, he became part of the stage because he was a fellow wolf.

I spoke to the guy. But he couldn't hear me.

A blood-covered wolf Constellation was looking at the sky.

He was talking to the stars that were laughing at him.

[Okay, if this is the story you guys want, look. However much.]

As I watched the wolf crashing into the unbreakable wall, I had a strange feeling for a moment.

I was swept away by emotion.

[Some Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Zodiac> rejoice at the fall of the wolf.]

Perhaps I too know the story of a man similar to me.

The man was born against his will and was caught up in a scenario that had nothing to do with his will.

He threw his life away many times to break the scenario, but he was never able to overcome the final 'wall'.

In the end, the 'wall' is,

[The story 'Heir To The Eternal Name' squirms.]

This is because it was a wall that only opened when opened from the other side.

I heard someone shouting at me. A sound of dissuasion. Indirect messages from the Constellations. Screams and howls.

All those voices mixed together like a discordant sound.

The moment I opened the door to the brick house, it dissipated like magic.

The scenery outside the house was surprisingly calm. Neither the indirect messages from the Constellations nor the screams of the incarnations were heard.

Raindrops falling from the gloomy sky.

A wolf Constellation wearing a bloody wolf mask was looking down at me.

I told the guy.

"Please come in."

[What?]

A sharp anger rose from the front paws of the wolf Constellation. It was expected that he would tear me to pieces at any moment.

"The game is over. Don’t you know that there is no way for you to win once「Staging」has occurred?"

The chance of success was slim, and the risk was too great.

Nevertheless, the reason I dare to do something like this is,

"You don’t seem to know, but this 'story' has no definite end."

Maybe it's because I have a similar story flowing through me.

"The Three Little Pigs is a traditional fairy tale. Depending on the oral tradition, there are various endings. It is the same that the three brothers worked together to defeat the wolf, but the story after that is different."

If I remember correctly, this story has an 'open ending'.

Like some story I know.

"In some versions, the wolf is thrown into boiling water and turns into soup. In other versions, the wolf is fried to death like popcorn. And in other versions—"

I know the chances are slim.

The probability that the ending I want will come is probably as low as the probability that <Kim Dokja Company> will finally get Kim Dokja back and they will all live together in a big house.

Nonetheless, if this gamble pays off...

"The wolf reconciles with the three little pigs and they live together in a brick house."

In this 41st Round, stories that were impossible in any world line may finally become possible.

[I—]

The wolf opened his mouth.

But unfortunately, the wolf had no say in this story.

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' is against your 'recycling method'.]

[The Constellation 'The Liverless Rabbit' is opposed to your 'recycling method'.]

[The Constellation 'The Philosopher's Words' questions your 'recycling method'.]

[Some zodiac signs strongly oppose your ending!]

With an ominous indirect message, the wolf's eyes began to turn red again.

[The probability of「Staging」is strengthened!]

Lightning struck from a stormy sky. A huge hole appeared beyond the swirling sky.

"Kim Dokja."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk hurriedly stepped in front of me and said.

"Something is wrong."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 730 Episode 28 House (8)

"I think so too."

In a situation like this, who doesn't know that something is wrong?

My mind was complicated.

Was the ending also a problem?

Constellations prefer certain revenge, unexpected developments, and exciting endings. But what I chose was the lukewarm ending called 'Reconciliation with Wolves'.

[Some Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Zodiac> are criticizing your actions!]

[A very small number of Constellations look dissatisfied with the outcome you chose.]

Of course, the Constellations would not like it.

If you think about it, something similar happened when Kim Dokja declared that he would not kill the 'Disaster of Floods'.

Geaaaa—!

'The Wolf Who CovetsLittle Red Riding Hood' began to struggle and howl. The guy, who had hit his head on the floor several times as if in pain, opened his eyes wide and looked up into space.

It was the same for me, little Yoo Joonghyuk, and the rest of the group.

Something was coming down the black open portal outside. At first, I thought it was an Outer God, but fortunately, that wasn’t the case.

The first thing I saw was a pig's head.

The moment I saw the whitish tail, a slight shiver ran down my spine.

There was no shock like when I met the Outer God or when the Historical-grade Constellations descended.

Still, my senses were warning me.

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' is glaring at you.]

They are the ones who occupy the lower sky of this star stream.

[The Constellation 'Pig That Builds Houses Out of Wood' is staring at you.]

They were great figures of the Chinese Zodiac.

[The Constellation 'Liverless Rabbit' is looking down at you.]

Indirect messages from the Constellations announcing their appearance one by one.

As many as three Constellations appeared at once, which would have been startling under normal circumstances.

However, despite that, there wasn't enough pressure felt.

Looking closely, I saw that each of the powerful Constellations had the appearance of a symbol.

...Is that why?

'The first pig to die' was a pig's head with a bill in its mouth.

'Pig that builds houses out of wood' is a log with a pig tail growing like sprouts.

Lastly, the 'liverless rabbit' was in the form of a bright red raw liver.

Anyway, I never imagined that the Constellations would come directly as symbols. This is because, no matter how 'symbolically' they descended, descending into a lower-level scenario incurs a considerable probability cost.

In my mind, I remembered the record of 'Ways of Survival' regarding the 'Recycling Center'.

「The Recycling Center is a kind of floating castle that travels around lower-tier scenarios.」

「The Recycling Center has a thin border with the other world in order to accommodate 'various types of stories'.」

「Constellations that have been recognized for their area within the Recycling Center can use symbols at a relatively low cost.」

Perhaps the reason the Constellations were able to descend as symbols was because of the special environment of the Recycling Center.

By the way, why did those bastards attempt to 'descend symbolically' at this moment?

They probably know that it's dangerous because they can't fully use their original power if they are in a symbolic state.

[It’s been a while, wolf.]

My doubts were quickly answered.

The moment I heard their mantra, I realized it right away.

[It’s still a smelly place.]

[Are there any new turtles?]

The fact that they took risks and attempted to 'descend symbolically' shows that they are confident.

[All the prisoners in Zone 13 kneel in front of the Nebula Zodiac.]

It was proof that no one in this 'Zone 13' would dare to oppose them.

The owner of the crane and the beastmen who were hiding in each house ran out of the house one by one to show their respect.

The same was true for our group. Ye Hyunwoo, Kyung Sein and Cha Yerin, and Dansu ahjussi were all prostrated on the floor.

It would not be their own will. This was simply the power of the Zodiac, the Nebula of animals.

[The Constellation 'The Wolf Who Loves Little Red Riding Hood' pays homage to the owner of the story.]

Little Red Riding Hood's wolf was also bowing his head to the floor.

The only ones who didn't kneel were Killer King, who was tied to a chair, me, and little Yoo Joonghyuk.

'The First Pig To Die' stared at me quietly and then spoke to the wolf Constellation.

[Have you forgotten your 'contract' with us?]

The wolf growled and his shoulders shook.

[No. Absolutely not.]

I didn't understand.

That one was just a pig and this one was a wolf.

Looking at the laws of the ecosystem and the logic of the law of the fittest, it was clear that carnivores were stronger than herbivores.

Nevertheless, the wolf was trembling like a prey that had encountered a top predator.

[You should be thankful just for continuing the lineage of parasites like you.]

The 'Liverless Rabbit' said sarcastically.

[Pig teachers, I told you so. All wolves should be killed. Do you know how many of my compatriots they preyed on?]

[I can't count them.]

[You should be grateful if you hired those guys as 'villains'. How dare you try to change the original story of a sacred tale?]

The wolf Constellation did not respond and just shed a sweat. I could see the story of the guy being crushed in real time screaming.

[Some Constellations of the Nebula <Zodiac> enjoy the suffering of the wolves.]

I think revenge for the weak is right. I also believe that the person who was harmed has the right to return what was harmed.

[Story fragment 'Hunted Wolf' cries.]

[Story fragment 'Little Red Riding Hood' cowers in fear.]

I had no intention of pointing out whether their ways were correct or not.

But…

No matter how I looked at it, this stage was somehow distorted.

[Didn’t you promise? You will pay for the crime your brother committed.]

Suddenly, a sentence from 'Ways of Survival' crossed my mind.

「Animal-shaped Constellations often take on the original sin of a race in exchange for sharing that story.」

Some stories go beyond individuals, to species, and even from generation to generation.

The wolf Constellation hurriedly put down his head and said.

[Well, didn’t we promise to raise a wolf as a tribute this month as well? The wolf will be ready.]

[It must be a plump wolf.]

[Of course. He gained weight by eating a lot of animal meat—]

Fragments of other beastmen's tales—the wolf harvesters who roamed around collecting 'meat' came to mind.

A hippopotamus struggling with its arm cut off. The prisoners donating meat but not blaming the wolves.

Is it.

Why did the wolves want 'meat'—

[That's strange. The wolves that have been coming up as tributes recently aren't that chubby, are they?]

[That's because of the lack of supply of stories in Zone 13... There are not enough recent local story fragments. If we no longer exploit prisoners—]

[Should I take your situation into consideration?]

[No! It was my mistake. I will offer up a wolf that has somehow grown fat, a wolf that has been fed a lot of story fragments, as an offering!]

Only then did I begin to understand many things.

The reason why the story fragments of the prisoners here were all a mess.

The reason why the arms and legs of prisoners were replaced with machines.

[We have already been patient enough.]

Just as the Constellations of <Olympus> used giants as their sacrifices, the pigs of <Zodiac> exploited other beastmen at the Recycling Center and received 'wolves' as tribute every month.

Just to continue their legacy.

[The story 'The Three Little Pigs' is complaining about hunger.]

The pig-headed symbol slowly descended to the ground and slowly looked around at the wolf incarnations.

The moment one of the wolf incarnations screamed and tried to run away, its head exploded.

The pig head laughed, chewing on the head wearing the wolf mask.

[He’s a guy who doesn’t even have anything to eat. I don’t even have enough soup to cook.]

[Sorry!]

[Can’t you hear the story’s voice? The story wants a sacrifice. Are you hoping that its existence will be erased from the <Star Stream>?]

[Please give me one more chance. I will do well!]

[Then.]

The Pig Constellation said.

[Prove it.]

He felt the fur on his arms rise. The sound of a story’s song reached my ears. The staging was starting again.

[Offer tribute.]

The wolf looked up at the pig's head with trembling eyes.

The Pig Constellation continued to speak.

[Reveal your ugly nature and die.]

At the pig's command, the wolf Constellation slowly stood up.

Ye Hyunwoo said while holding my sleeve.

"We need to get into the house."

Kyung Sein was the same.

"Inho-ssi! It’s none of our business. Run away. Quickly. If you don’t run now—"

The prisoners who were prostrated hung their heads and trembled.

"Oh, no! Please forgive the wolf! Forgive him!"

"Please, great <Zodiac>—"

Little Red Riding Hood’s wolf looked back at them. He saw prisoners with missing limbs and fragments of their stories that had lost their speech.

And he said.

[All right. I will be the 'tribute'.]

From the beginning, this was a story with a fixed end. A story that everyone can watch with confidence. There is a set protagonist, and the stage ends only when the set villain dies.

[「Staging」resumes.]

An ominous aura began to flow from the entire body of the Wolf Constellation.

That wasn't all.

Our brick house was growing.

[The influence of the story fragment 'Brick House' becomes stronger!]

A brick house that looks as if it can withstand any wolf attack, reminiscent of Gong Pildu's [Armed Fortress].

"Ah, ah, it was all wrong—"

"Everyone run away!"

The frightened prisoners began to run away one by one into the brick house.

The 'pig that died first', who was watching with satisfaction, looked back at me for the last time.

[The one who is favored by monkeys. You found the right answer. Our story will become even greater with the 'brick' you found.]

[Don’t even think about interfering. If you successfully complete the story, you will also receive a reward.]

With those last words, the Constellations ascended back to heaven.

[Some Constellations in the Nebula <Zodiac> want the destruction of the wolves.]

The muscles of the wolf Constellation began to twitch. It was a sign that the power of「staging」was about to dominate his entire body.

"Stop!"

I shouted at the guy.

But my words didn't reach him. A fierce wind was already blowing throughout the entire body of the Wolf Constellation.

Little Yoo Joonghyuk, who was standing next to me, took a step forward and said.

"Are you planning to change the story?"

I nodded.

"Pig? It’s just like the Chinese Zodiac guys say. If you stay like this, you can get a new story."

"I know. But if that happens, the remaining incarnations in this area will—"

"You must have felt it from the beginning: the 'beasts' here wanted us to become the wolves’ victims."

I know. So, the crane owner guided us to an old 'guest house'.

"The wolves here exploit these beastmen to obtain fragments of stories. They feed them to one of the wolves and offer them as an 'sacrifice' to the pigs."

"…"

"Whether the beastmen or the wolves die is none of your business."

"That too. But—"

"This world calls that hypocrisy."

Hypocrisy.

I laughed bitterly.

"This world looks a lot like a place I used to know."

It was sweet, but definitely different.

The 'Demon World' I knew was not like this. Good and evil were a little more clear than this.

Maybe this is also a result of 'recycling'.

"I don’t have any particular cause. I just—"

What would Kim Dokja do?

"I just don’t like this story."

I didn't even think I could persuade him. However,

"If you oppose the Chinese Zodiac, you will die."

I hesitated for a moment and asked.

"Are you really worried about me?"

"If it takes just a moment, you can break through."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk's small fists were filled with unusual magical energy.

「100 Steps Divine Fist.」

It was impossible. Because [Skills] cannot be used in this worldview. Even when he became a kid, Yoo Joonghyuk is still Yoo Joonghyuk?

The guy created his skill [100 Steps Divine Fist] purely through his own talent.

"Please."

Yoo Joonghyuk's fist punched into the air. In an instant, an explosive vortex surrounded the wolf, creating a wound in the wind.

I dug into the gap and grabbed the Wolf Constellation by the shoulder.

"I told you to stop!"

My voice was scattered in the harsh wind. To the point where communication is barely possible. At this rate, outside Constellations will not be able to hear our voices.

[The house… Go in. You… This story… It cannot be changed.]

It was not simply because of 「staging」. The guy's long Story's shadow was looming.

"Did they cause your Story to make us run away?"

[If you are at home… safe. There… Remember the wolf's last story.]

I knew of several Constellations where shadows had run away.

He will die soon.

Even if he doesn't die, he will be in the same state as dead.

The Wolf Constellation laughed as if it had read my eyes.

[Me… Are you sympathizing?]

"Pity? Do you think I'm such an idle person?"

To begin with, the <Star Stream> is a broken world.

This world is just a 'story'.

All stories sparkle and are consumed by fleeting emotions.

Over a long period of history, causes and effects have become mixed, and harm and damage have become indistinguishable.

All that remains is the laughter and cheers of the stars.

Even though I know that,

"Don't you want to create a new 'story' of wolves?"

I can't give up on the story.

This is the last story in which he will shine as a Constellation.

After hitting that brick house several times, he will fall down the chimney and die a horrible death.

And to future generations of wolves, he will be remembered as the new wolf of 「The Three Little Pigs」.

"Are you really going to end it like this?"

The Wolf Constellation's eyebrows twitched greatly.

[You guy… there's…]

"I know what you're going to say. There's nothing you can do. You're going to die anyway. The Zodiac is a Nebula you can't handle."

Even though he is a Constellation, he is a fallen Constellation who has lost all his stories.

No matter what he does, he cannot beat the <Zodiac>. It is impossible to destroy the 'stage' that has been solidified by the gaze of Constellations over hundreds and thousands of years.

But there are things even such a Constellation can do.

"Sacrifice your Story to summon the God of the Other World."

Ruining this stage.

[What… Are you talking nonsense? If you do something like that…]

"The existing 'stage' will be destroyed. And a new story will begin."

The wolf's eyes widened as if wondering what I was talking about.

[Then Zone 13 is—]

"Don't worry. I will stop the God of the Other World'."

The wolf's voice trembled harshly, as if he belatedly understood what I meant.

[You can't possibly be—]

"That's right."

I nodded.

"I plan to steal the story of 'The Three Little Pigs'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 731 Episode 28 House (9)

The Wolf Constellation, whose expression was distorted, shouted.

[What nonsense—]

Even when I thought about it, it was crazy.

It might sound strange to say that we would steal the story of「The Three Little Pigs」. However, if this <Star Stream> really was a world that worked as I thought and as Kim Dokja read, it was not an impossible story at all.

"Shut up and listen to me."

The tone of my voice was unfamiliar. Is this really my voice, or is it the remnants of the story that the 'Demon King of Salvation' left me?

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' listens to your story.]

It didn't matter either way.

However, if Kim Dokja is also reading this story, if he is also seeing me from somewhere in this world,

[A Constellation whose modifier has not yet been revealed is looking at you.]

At least I want to tell him a story that is not embarrassing.

"However, you must not summon just any 'Outer God'."

I took a deep breath and spat out the words. Because now is the important part.

"The Outer God to be summoned is—"

The surrounding wind was getting stronger again. I desperately raised my voice. I couldn't tell if the wolf heard me or not.

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' is furious!]

The sparks that came from the wolf's whole body bounced me away. In the dizzy spinning vision, something small caught me.

It was little Yoo Joonghyuk.

He picked me up and quickly ran towards the brick house. Kyung Sein quickly came out to meet us, pushed little Yoo Joonghyuk into the brick house and closed the door.

One by one, the prisoners hiding in the brick house looked up from between the tables and looked at me. Some people looked at me with resentment, and some looked at me with fear.

There were also people who were worried about me.

"What the hell are you thinking? You're going to die! You're really going to die!"

Kyung Sein was crying.

"What's wrong with your head? You've really come to think that you've become Kim Dokja!"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk turned his head and looked up at Kyung Sein. However, it seemed like Kyung Sein had no energy left to defend the concept.

"Please, please, stay hidden here! You'll be safe if you stay hidden."

The Kyung Sein I knew was a very timid person. She was the one who was afraid of the ground rats. The person who was hiding behind Jung Heewon.

But I also remember other aspects of her.

A person who endured Yoo Joonghyuk's hellish training.

A person who threw her body to stop monsters in order to save the characters in the novel.

A person who risked her life several times to protect me and the others.

"It’s a story that has nothing to do with us. Just stay still. Then it will pass."

She was never the type of person to say things like this.

"It doesn’t matter."

"Huh?"

"They are the ones who turned you into a prisoner."

I looked at my colleagues standing behind her. Ye Hyunwoo, Dansu ahjussi, and Cha Yerin.

"Didn’t you all come here before me? You probably know better than me what Zone 13 is like."

Solving event scenarios is important. But that alone wasn't enough.

My companions had already lost their masks and failed the scenario.

In order to save them, there is no choice but to break the 'rules of Zone 13'.

And for them.

「I must face the <Zodiac>.」

Kyung Sein looked at me with blank eyes. Her eyebrows were fluttering.

"Aren’t you afraid of the Constellations?"

"It’s scary."

It’s scary. It's really scary.

Because I was scared of those guys, I also ran all the way here.

"But I’ve also seen guys that are scarier than them."

It was different from what I had imagined. The power of the stars was beyond what I thought.

The power to literally split mountains and seas.

Even now, when I close my eyes, the image of Ares fighting against the 'Demon King of Salvation' clearly comes to mind. I had no confidence that I could face such a monster.

"The enemy we must defeat is at a height so high that it cannot even be compared to that of the Zodiac."

However, even Ares was only one of the 12 gods of <Olympus>.

The sky in the <Star Stream> is so distant.

"We must not lose to the Constellations. We must not see the world the way they see it. We must—"

No matter how hard I struggle, I cannot defeat the Constellations now.

I could tell just by looking at their symbols. But I couldn't just obey their rules just because I couldn't beat them.

"We are readers."

Each of my colleagues raised their heads or looked at the ground to see what they were thinking.

In the short silence, the strong wind outside the house was gradually getting stronger.

It was Cha Yerin who opened her mouth first.

"How."

"My sister is asking how she can help."

"From now on, we will change the narrative."

The core of this event scenario is to change the fundamental story of 「The Three Little Pigs」.

Even if this is accomplished successfully, the changed narrative will be nothing more than dust.

But now I desperately wanted that one speck of dust.

"Just like Kim Dokja did."

"It is a story that has already been staged. You know that it is not easy to change."

"That’s true. But it’s not impossible either."

The power of「staging」once activated is absolute. The power of the stage overturns even differences in power.

At least as long as「The Three Little Pigs」is activated, the 'Wolf' will never be able to destroy the 'Brick House'.

"I’ve already created a foreshadowing."

If it's just an ordinary 'wolf'.

Coo coo coo coo coo.

This is a gamble.

Just as Kim Dokja risked his life every time, I too will have to risk my life this time.

Fortunately, we have this 'brick house'.

It may not be as reliable as the [Fourth Wall] that Kim Dokja had, but at least as long as this 'brick house' exists—

[Story fragment 'Brick House' becomes stronger.]

We will definitely have an opportunity to turn this situation around.

It was then that the sound of the wind stopped.

I could see the wolf Constellation fluttering outside the window. The guy's long Story’s shadow was finally reaching the sky.

[The Constellation 'Pig That Dies First' is greatly shocked!]

[The Constellation 'Pig That Built Its House Out of Wood' is furious at the wolf’s judgment!]

[The Constellation 'Liverless Rabbit' is surprised by the wolf’s choice!]

[Some Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Zodiac> condemn the atrocities of the wolves!]

Looking at the reactions of the Constellations,

[The Constellation 'The Wolf Who Loves Little Red Riding Hood' is famous.]

It seemed like things were going well.

"This—"

Dansu ahjussi, who felt an unusual current, took a step back.

"Did he really summon an Outer God?"

Through the pitch-black dust, a small 'Great Hall' was visible in the sky. Although it was smaller than the 'Great Hall' I saw before, it was definitely a 'Great Hall'.

"Oh my god."

"Ah ah ah ah ah—"

"It’s all over! It’s all over!"

The prisoners who entered the inn together also seemed to know about the 'Great Hall' and held their heads under the table.

Well, they too must have been incarnations of scenarios at one time.

Tsutsutsu!

The probability aftermaths near the 'Great Hall' were weaker than usual.

I heard that the 'Recycling Center' has a thin border with the other world, so maybe that's why.

Unless—

[A God of the Other World prepares for his descent.]

"Uh, what should we do, Dokja-ssi!"

Meanwhile, Kyung Sein, who had recovered a little bit of her mentality, started calling me Dokja.

"If even a 'Great Old One' appears—"

Then, from now on, I will have to live up to my name.

"Not all deities in this world are of the 'Great Old One' level. You know that."

Rather, most of the 'Outer Gods' are closer to nameless things. Strange monsters that have lost their ego and wander the world lines.

"Still, it’s a problem. If someone like the 'Dream Eater' shows up, Zone 13 will be over!"

"It would be of a lower level than that."

In the main story, the 'Dream Eater' descended.

However, the 'Dream Eater' is a being who has been summoned as a sacrifice by the story of a 'Narrative-grade Constellation'.

On the other hand, what was offered as a sacrifice this time was the story of a 'Historical-grade Constellation', which had lost most of its own stories.

"If a guy like that had appeared, all the Constellations would have run away. But look, they’re still watching."

[Very few Constellations are frightened by the existence of the 'Outer God'.]

[The Constellations from the Nebula <Zodiac> are astonished by the 'Outer God' who appears in the scenario!]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' makes an interested expression.]

Although they are afraid, they are maintaining their position. That means that the guy who appears now is at least of a lower grade than the 'Dream Eater'.

The next moment, the sound of something hitting the roof was heard.

Thud. Thud. Thud.

The house, which had been shielded from the wolf’s wind until now, was shaking precariously.

After all, no matter what it was summoned for, an 'Outer God' is an 'Outer God'.

[Fragment of the story 'Brick House' falls silent.]

I said, putting my hand on the wall.

"Don’t worry. Even if it is an 'Outer God', they are not free from「staging」."

Deities from another world.

Beings excluded from the scenario and wandering the outer reaches of the <Star Stream>.

However, that does not mean they are completely free from 'stories'. Once they become involved in a scenario, they also become bound by the rules of the scenario.

The problem is which guy showed up.

I glared at the darkness outside the window. However, perhaps because of the dust that filled the darkness, the descending god of the other world could not be seen.

I don't know, but he probably took over the body of the wolf Constellation. And, following his will, he will try to destroy this 'Brick House'.

Kudddddddd.

The ground was shaking unusually.

A completely different sign than before.

"Kim Dokja."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk also had a serious expression.

"The 'wind' has changed."

I was feeling it too. The wind blowing from beyond this 'wall' was on a completely different level from the wind blowing from the wolf Constellation so far.

It feels as if the god of storms had descended.

"What kind of Outer God has appeared—"

"Maybe something like the 'Wolf of Destruction' came?"

Ye Hyunwoo answered Kyung Sein’s question.

"The 'Wolf of Destruction' is not a God from Another World. He is a Constellation from <Asgard>."

"But Hyunwoo, are you able to speak normally?"

"Only the Seventh Apostle reacts like that."

The house began to shake violently.

I clung to the wall, trying my best to pretend to be calm. It was definitely not a reassuring situation.

"Everyone, please stick to the wall and supply magical power."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk was the first to come out, and the other members of the group also clung to the wall one by one.

The faces of the companions who sensed the shaking of the wall turned pale.

"Dokja-ssi, I don’t think I can last long. At this rate—"

"Don’t worry. It won’t break."

"But I think our magical power alone won’t be enough."

Right. It would take a huge amount of mana to maintain a 'brick house' of this size.

And above all—

"The brick house is barely a 'story fragment'."

It was just as little Yoo Joonghyuk said.

The status of the 'brick house’s story' was too low.

A 'fragment of a story' that did not even become a story.

Even lower class.

"But that’s okay. Brick houses don’t collapse, because—"

I added, grinning as I stared into the darkness beyond the sky.

"If this 'Brick House' breaks down, there are people who will lose something bigger than us."

[The story 'The Three Little Pigs' stutters its storytelling.]

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' urgently supports the story!]

[The Constellation 'Pig Building a House of Wood' requests reinforcement from other Constellations!]

Killer King, who was tied to the chair, seemed to have realized my intention only then and groaned.

"No way, you Kim Dokja."

"Yes, that’s right."

"So, the deity of this world—"

Ye Hyunwoo also nodded his head as if he understood the situation.

"I see. If the 'wolf' wins here—"

"History will change. So the Constellations can’t ever give up."

[The story of 'The Three Little Pigs' continues.]

[The story fragment 'Brick House' is strengthened!]

"Because this is their 'origin story'."

My operation is simple.

「To simultaneously destroy the Constellations of the Chinese zodiac and the 'God of the Other World'.」

The Constellations hidden in the darkness were not visible.

But I could feel their anger and fear.

"They can never give up. So—"

Not ending this「stage」until all the stars fall.

[The synchronization rate between you and your sponsor increases significantly!]

"Let’s create a story that will last forever."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' smiles mysteriously.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 732 Episode 28 House (10)

Lee Jihye still remembers the day she first met Kim Dokja.

In the dark Chungmuro Station tunnel, a man with a white face appeared like a ghost through the Specter area.

「"Who are you guys? Don’t you know that this area is our hunting ground?"」

Right. That was her first meeting with Kim Dokja.

「"…Did you guys come here after defeating the specters?"」

Lee Jihye stood in the tunnel, looking down at the fragments of the story that continued their storytelling.

"Ahjussi, if you’re in a place like this, they're scattered ."

She bent down and picked up a fragment of her story. This fragment was the purpose of her visit to this 'world line'.

[The story fragment 'First Meeting with the Maritime Admiral' has been obtained.]

Lee Jihye smiled faintly after checking the name of the story fragment.

"This also becomes a story."

She’s a little happy.

This meeting remains recorded. She realized that her ahjussi made up a part of her that she cherished during her time living with him.

"Hmm. I guess it’s no longer here."

After retrieving the fragment, Lee Jihye looked around her several times before activating the Kim Dokja tracker that Lee Seolhwa had made.

[There are no 'Kim Dokja Fragments' in this world line.]

Her mission, she said in <Kim Dokja Company>, is to collect Kim Dokja’s fragments scattered around the world.

At first, she was with her companions, but after 'a number of Kim Dokja fragments were discovered in the 41st Round', the only one left to wander around other world lines and collect the story fragments was Lee Jihye.

So many months.

Finally, the 'fragments' of the target were almost resolved.

"It’s been a while since I’ll be returning home. Biyoo! Send me back!"

A moment later, a 'baaat' sound was heard in her head and the portal inside her swirled around, sucking her into it.

[You have reached the target dimension.]

"Utcha."

The transfer was instantaneous.

When she first started traveling around the world, she wasn't able to travel back and forth this fast, so perhaps her metaphorical abilities have grown over time.

Lee Jihye, who came out of the portal, took in a breath and shouted loudly.

"I’m here—!"

But despite her cries, there was no sign of her companions.

Lee Jihye felt a little sad and trudged her feet to find her companions.

"I’m here! Where has everyone gone!"

The moment she opened the transmission room and turned down the hallway across from her.

"Ah, is Jihye here?"

"Seolhwa unnie!"

She ran into Lee Seolhwa, who looked tired for some reason.

Lee Seolhwa immediately grabbed Lee Jihye's wrist and muttered something to her, then nodded her head and said:

"You’re healthy. Your balance is stable, I was worried a lot."

"Why are you worried about other people?"

"Huh? Jihye noona!"

When she turned around, she saw Lee Gilyoung and Shin Yoosung coming out of the room.

"Unnie!"

Shin Yoosung rushed over and hugged Lee Jihye.

"Wow, you’ve grown up a lot, my little girl."

She stroked Shin Yoosung’s head. Seeing Lee Jihye and Shin Yoosung getting along well, Lee Gilyoung made a yuck sound.

“What about Sangah unnie?"

Shin Yoosung suddenly raised her head and answered.

"She’s in the observation room. We’re all on our way there at the same time."

"Is Master there too?"

"The sooty guy is in the closed training room."

"Again? Master says I have some training left to do."

"He’s recovering from internal injuries."

"Has Master suffered internal injuries?"

"He got into a fight with a Myth-grade Constellation."

A Mythical Constellation.

Lee Jihye's expression hardened slightly.

"Mythical grade?"

There were almost no Constellations left that could pose a threat to the current <Kim Dokja Company>.

However, if the target is 'Myth-grade', the story is a little different.

"Odin. And the Narrative-grade scoundrels of <Asgard>."

Lee Jihye opened her mouth.

"What, did Master really turn the situation around?"

"That bastard is as strong as he was originally."

"No, that’s only when the conditions are the same! That’s their world line. What about the probability aftermath?"

"That’s why he got hurt like that."

"Sooyoung said you left it alone?"

When Han Sooyoung's name came up, the expressions of her companions visibly darkened.

Lee Jihye asked while carefully observing the eyes of her companions.

"What’s wrong with everyone’s expressions? Why did Master fight with Odin? Did Dokja ahjussi even show up?"

Lee Gilyoung and Shin Yoosung looked at each other.

Lee Jihye felt trouble.

"Wait a minute. Really?"

"To be exact, it was a 'hugely large fragment' of hyung."

"A huge fragment?"

"A fragment with the story of 'Demon King of Salvation'."

"At that level, he’s almost like him, isn’t he?"

"He’s not 100% my hyung."

In response to Lee Gilyoung's answer, Shin Yoosung glared at Lee Gilyoung.

Lee Jihye observed the nervous battle between the two, then tapped the two children on the shoulders and opened her mouth.

"Lee Gilyoung. That’s what I thought about when I was walking around collecting fragments."

"One thought."

"After all, no human being can be 100 percent."

At that solemn declaration, Shin Yoosung suddenly raised her head, and Lee Seolhwa also muttered, "Oh my," and covered her mouth.

Lee Jihye let out a triumphant voice towards Lee Gilyoung, who was making a bad expression.

"Why? Are you impressed by this sister’s insight?"

"It’s amazing that my noona thought of something like that."

"Do you want to hang upside down for the first time in a long time? Anyway, what I want to say is—"

"You’re saying I should accept it even if my hyung’s return isn’t 100% perfect."

"Hmm..."

"Do you think I'm stupid? I know that too. But—"

In the first place, no human being can be '100 percent'. Because humans always lose and forget something.

The only thing Lee Gilyoung is afraid of is.

"What if hyung, who I barely got back, forgot about noona?"

"Uh?"

"Can you still say that? Can you say with confidence that it’s okay even if he’s not 100% hyung?"

Lee Jihye looked blankly into Lee Gilyoung’s eyes. And then she saw Shin Yoosung and again Lee Seolhwa.

"That’s not possible. Of course he has to remember me."

"What, just now—"

"It’s unfair. I can’t even go to MIT and I’m doing this here, and if that person had forgotten about me—"

"You didn’t get accepted into college."

"It’s okay. He remembers me, so I don’t have to worry about that."

"How does noona know that?"

"You’ll be surprised when you see what I brought."

Lee Jihye, with a meaningful expression on her face, put her hand into her backpack.

But where were they?

Apparently, the fragments of Kim Dokja that she had put in her backpack were not in her hands.

That couldn't have been possible.

She has certainly collected a lot from her travels around the world —

"Eh?"

The moment Lee Jihye dropped her backpack on the floor in surprise, something quickly jumped out from inside her backpack.

Lee Jihye's eyes widened.

"Oh my god."

Shin Yoosung screamed.

"Ahjussi!"

Kkoma Kim Dokja, the size of a small doll, was looking up at his companions.

The first to move were Shin Yoosung and Lee Gilyoung.

"Where!"

"Move, Shin Yoosung!"

Kkoma Kim Dokja ran somewhere to avoid the two children.

"Catch him!"

The group hurriedly chased after kkoma Kim Dokja.

How long did they run like that?

"Ah."

The place kkoma Kim Dokja headed to was the observation room where Yoo Sangah was located.

The sound of a door opening.

Yoo Sangah and kkoma Kim Dokja, who were checking the monitor in the observation room, met their other's eyes.

Yoo Sangah looked down at kkoma Kim Dokja, who opened his mouth in surprise. Kkoma Kim Dokja raised both of his hands towards Yoo Sangah. Looking down at the kkoma Kim Dokja whom Yoo Sangah knew, she soon smiled bitterly and asked.

"Did you miss me that much?"

Yoo Sangah stretched out her hand and carefully picked up the kkoma Kim Dokja and placed him on her table.

As the gaze changed from day to day, kkoma Kim Dokja's eyes turned to the monitor in the observation room.

The story of the '41st Round' was being played there.

Inside the monitor, a masked man was speaking.

"I plan to steal the story of “The Three Little Pigs."

The man's shining eyes and white skin were glimpsed through the area that the mask could not cover.

Before they knew it, the arriving party members were also looking at the screen.

Yoo Sangah waved her hand.

"Has Jihye arrived?"

"Yes, unnie. But maybe that…"

Yoo Sangah saw the man yelling beyond the screen.

He is a man who clears storms and negotiates with wolves.

"Right? He is Dokja, right?"

A man who hides his companions in a brick house and confronts the scenario in a way no one could have imagined.

Yoo Sangah watched the man’s story.

—Let’s create a story that will last forever.

It would take several books to tell exactly who he is.

Yoo Sangah was not the person who could have written that book. Because the only person who could decide the contents of the book was the man himself.

Instead, Yoo Sangah was able to read the title of the book.

"Yes, he is Dokja-ssi."

"Of course. Who else would do something like that other than him? Shouldn’t we help him? If he dies like that—"

"Not now. There is no extra probability."

"Damn it, it’s all because of that sooty guy! That bastard got into a fight with Odin…"

"What happened to the Constellations in our world line? Can we contact them?"

"Yoo Sangah, there is still a situation where we can easily communicate—"

At that time, kkoma Kim Dokja, who was being held in Yoo Sangah's arms, flinched his shoulder.

At the same time, a strong probability storm began to blow beyond the screen.

Beyond the great hall that opened above the sky, a God of Another World was being summoned.

"What."

However, the expressions on the faces of the party members who confirmed the summoned 'God of Another World' were strange.

"That… That’s him, right?"

---

The storm pounded on the brick house.

Every time the wind hit the wall, it felt like the house would be uprooted.

The power of the 'God of the Other World' was stronger than I thought.

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' breaks into a cold sweat.]

It looks like the Pig Constellations that are slowly supporting it are also having a hard time.

Kyung Sein asked.

"What kind of guy was summoned?"

I recalled what I said to the Wolf Constellation.

In order to overcome this situation, I asked him to 'designate summon' the 'God of Another World' that I wanted.

"I think—"

"The story is getting weaker!"

Dansu ahjussi shouted urgently.

[The voice of the story 'The Three Little Pigs' decreases.]

That couldn't have been possible.

If this story collapses, the Constellations will lose their origin story. At best, for those who are considered historical-grade, the 'origin story' is the story that determines their status. To protect their position, they will not give up until the very end.

Nevertheless, if the story has become weaker...

[The conditions for the reproduction of 'staging' are incomplete.]

Damn, there's that too.

It was staged incompletely from the beginning.

In order to fully recreate this stage, a 'youngest pig' was needed to stand against the 'wolf.'

But we just fulfilled the conditions 'The Three Little Pigs' through expedient means.

[Fragment of the story 'The Last Born' begins its storytelling.]

One is a fragment of the story of the 'youngest' Kim Dokja.

[Fragment of the story 'The man who ate eight meals a day' begins its storytelling.]

The other was a fragment of Yoo Joonghyuk's story.

"Kim Dokja."

But from earlier, little Yoo Joonghyuk's expression was strange.

"I'm hungry."

What?

[Fragment of the story 'The man who eats eight meals a day' complains of hunger.]

No, wait a minute. Is there any reason why I should be anxious about the 'stage adaptation'?

"Everyone! Food! Please bring me food!"

"Huh? Why is food suddenly—"

"Hurry! I have to feed this bastard!"

For some reason, I thought that little Yoo Joonghyuk's strength was noticeably weaker. This guy, who was supposed to eat eight meals a day, ended up like this because he couldn't eat even one meal properly.

The good news among the misfortunes is that this is an inn.

"Food! Give me food! Owner!"

Kyung Sein thanked the crane owner and quickly served the food.

Freshly boiled soup, freshly steamed sweet potatoes and potatoes. Wheat bread with jam, etc. Even at first glance, the food looked quite delicious.

I shouted to Kyung Sein.

"Feed him! Feed him eight meals at once!"

"Huh? Can I feed him like that?"

"Hurry!"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk is unable to use his hands as he is busy supplying magical power to the 'Brick House'.

Kyung Sein, who hastily made soup, took the spoon to little Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Now, aah. Do it, aah!"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly turned his head.

"I hate it."

"Huh? Why? You said you were hungry."

Kyung Sein tilted her head and smelled the soup.

"I didn’t put anything poisonous or anything! Look! Delicious food that I can eat too…"

I didn't understand.

Yoo Joonghyuk refused food.

Why?

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' speaks.]

Lately, I felt like my head was pounding.

Damn, now that I think about it, Yoo Joonghyuk had 'that kind of setting'.

Yoo Joonghyuk, frowning, looked up at me and declared.

"I don’t eat food prepared by others."

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 733 Episode 28 House (11)

Ye Hyunwoo, Cha Yerin, and Dansu ahjussi, who were supplying magical power, turned to look at Yoo Joonghyuk at the same time.

The expressions on their faces asked if he was really speaking in his right mind.

Dansu ahjussi with cognitive dissonance asked.

"What did you just say…"

I could also hear Ye Hyunwoo muttering quietly.

"Ha, there was a setting like that."

Killer King, who was tied to a chair, also shook his head in admiration.

"He was the true Supreme King."

He is truly the Supreme King, and if he continues like this, the entire story will fall apart. The brick house was getting thinner in real time.

[The representation of 'staging' is weakened!]

When the「staging」collapses, the tale will stop its storytelling.

In that case, the Constellations that were forcibly tied to this stage will be able to leave the scene without any significant damage.

[Some of the Constellations in the nebula <Zodiac> are taunting you.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' makes an excited expression.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' is curious about your plan.]

If things continued like this, everything, whether it was a plan or not, was going to fall apart along with this brick house.

The dust and sand that fell down scattered on my face. I looked down at the fallen dirt and asked.

"Can’t you just not eat 'food' made by others?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me.

"What?"

“Isn’t it enough to fill your stomach no matter what you feed it?"

"You, you can’t—"

For the first time, a feeling of fear appeared in little Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes. Anyway, I held the powder in my hand and brought it to his mouth.

"Eat, you bastard!"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk stubbornly rebelled.

My companions looked at me at the same time.

"Are you really feeding him dirt right now?"

"No, no matter how you can do that to a child—"

"As expected, Kim Dokja."

I ignored their words and forced little Yoo Joonghyuk's mouth open and let out what was in my hand. Yoo Joonghyuk's trembling neck moved.

I barely sighed and said.

"You can’t eat real dirt, right?"

Of course, it might be possible to use the [Incite] skill, but I didn't want to go that far here.

"Ah."

Cha Yerin found a small piece on my hand and let out a small exclamation. It seemed like she realized late what this was.

What I fed was fragments of stories.

More precisely, it was a part of the 'story fragment' that the 'Heir of the Eternal Name' had swallowed.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' looks dissatisfied.]

[Your lifespan decreases.]

A 'story fragment' that I managed to obtain through my earnest request.

"If it’s a story fragment, this guy could eat it too."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who has had a twisted personality since birth, has a 'set value' in which he does not eat food unless he has made it himself.

Of course, there is an exception with 'Murim dumplings', but I don't know how to make them.

So the next best option was 'story fragments'.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Come to your senses."

This is because even Yoo Joonghyuk, who does not eat food prepared by others, has received stories from other people.

The problem is that the look in Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes when he received it was slightly bitter.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

If possible, I wanted to avoid doing this.

In 'Ways of Survival', it is said that Yoo Joonghyuk once received a wrong transfusion of military story from Lee Hyunsung and briefly turned around.

But for now there was no other way. I had to feed him something to fill his stomach.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' grins.]

Wait for a sec. But what is the story that Yoo Joonghyuk is obsessed with now?

Yoo Joonghyuk was trembling and his eyes were rolling. The guy just looked up at me and put his head down on the floor.

And.

"No, wait a minute."

Wack wack. Wack wack.

"Hey! Spit it out! Pick something up and eat it!"

Either way, the guy started digging up the dirt. Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes slowly returned to their senses. The guy with dirt on the corner of his mouth glared at me with wide eyes.

"You bastard, you made me suffer, right?"

The loud-mouthed Killer King answered for me.

"It’s dirt."

"I don’t eat dirt."

"No, you eat dirt. That’s Yoo Joonghyuk."

Killer King pointed to the window with his chin. Little Yoo Joonghyuk looked at his own mouth reflected in the window with blank eyes.

I tried my best to ignore the look in the eyes of little Yoo Joonghyuk.

[Story fragment 'The man who eats eight meals a day' is satisfied.]

[The conditions for 'staging' have been met.]

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' screams.]

The story has been enriched once again. As the crumbling stage became solid once more, the Pig Constellations that had been preparing to step back rushed forward again.

[The Constellation 'Pig who built his house out of wood' groans.]

Cheer up, pigs. If you don’t want the story to be taken away by a wolf.

[Some Constellations in the nebula <Zodiac> are showing hostility towards you.]

The storm started to rage again.

---

I don't know how much time has passed. Have I been this exhausted since I was trapped in the ichthyosaur's stomach?

[The head of the Recycling Center admires your determination.]

The party members who were supplying magical energy were also exhausted one by one. Some people were leaning against the wall, gasping for breath or completely fainting.

I too was on the verge of losing my mind. What made me endure was the story engraved on the other side of the wall.

「A wolf howled in the storm.」

A storm came and the brick house withstood the wind. A story was created every time the wind left a scar on the wall.

「A lone wolf who lost his home asked.」

It is a new story of wolves.

「"Is that your home?"asked the lone wolf.」

「"Then where is my home?"」

The brick house did not answer.

「"If I can’t have a house."」

Then the wolf spoke.

「"I will not stop the storm until every house in the world is destroyed."」

All stories are written on the 'wall'.

Because there is a wall, events finally become 'stories' and the Constellations can safely indulge in stories.

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' is impressed by your 'hands-on-slaughter' skill.]

[Animal-shaped Constellations that are not part of the Chinese zodiac are amazed by your story.]

Yeah, feel free to take a look.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' likes the sensibility of the wolves.]

[Some Constellations from the Chinese Zodiac are angry at your story.]

I used the characteristic of [Circulatory Conservation] to gather as much magical energy as possible to strengthen the 'Brick House'.

I wanted to make this story continue a little longer.

[The Constellation 'The First Pig To Die' screams!]

[The Constellation 'Pig That Built its House out of Wood' cries out for help!]

It was then that something snapped.

I felt my stomach turn, and a handful of blood spilled onto the floor. My head was dizzy.

The moment I raised my head to see what was going on.

[The story 'The Three Little Pigs' is destroyed.]

[Some of the Constellations corresponding to 'Pig' in the Chinese zodiac have suffered a huge blow to their true bodies!]

[The Constellation 'The Pig That Died First' exits the scenario.]

[The Constellation 'The Pig That Built its House out of Wood' exits the scenario.]

Only then did I realize what had happened.

['Staging' ends.]

The Constellations were defeated.

['The God of the Other World' roars!]

[Some of the Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Zodiac> are afraid of the 'God of the Other World'.]

Perhaps it was natural.

No matter how low the level of the 'God of the Other World' was, there was no way that a historical-grade Constellation could rush in and suppress the power of the Outer God.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' mocks the Constellations, asking if they are just that scared.]

From now on, it was a complete gamble.

"Don’t open the door."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk spoke quietly as if he knew what I was going to do.

"If you go out, you will die."

"Even if we stay here, everyone is still going to die."

"But—"

"Do not worry."

I lightly tapped little Yoo Joonghyuk on the shoulder and then spoke.

"No one will die."

When I opened the door, the streets of Zone 13 appeared, engulfed in silence.

It was strange. It's so quiet even though a storm is raging.

Nevertheless, the pressure pressing down on my entire body was several times stronger than when I faced the 'Wolf Constellation' earlier.

It didn't take long to realize what was happening.

「Eye of the storm.」

Now our 'Brick House' was exactly in the 'center' of the storm.

Now,「Staging」cannot protect us. If the storm twists in any direction, the brick house will be torn to pieces.

"O great god of the other world."

I took a slow, deep breath and said.

"Stop the storm. Haven't you had enough of the stories?"

A new story that sprouts in the place where the story of「The Three Little Pigs」was destroyed.

[Your new story begins to germinate.]

This story will now become the story of the wolf and us.

And maybe the 'God of the Other World' who led this storm can also receive a share.

"The ending of every story is important."

'Gods of the Other World' have different levels depending on the status they have.

The ancient species that once shook the entire scenario is crowned as the 'Old One', and the dominant species that filled the entire universe with fear is crowned as the 'Great Old One'.

But whatever their original grade, they all have something in common.

"You can now go 'home'."

Deities who were excluded from the scenario and lost their Constellations bodies to stay in.

They endlessly wander around the world, looking for a place where they belong. After a long wandering, someone becomes a disaster in another world line, and someone else even colludes with Dokkaebis.

"The story can only be completed if you stop the storm here."

And someone makes an 'otherworldly covenant'.

['The God of Another World' is looking at you.]

All 'Gods of the Other World' are terribly lonely.

"It means you will have a Constellation body to stay in."

My body trembled just from him looking at me. If it was a normal incarnation, it wouldn't be strange if blood spilled from my eyes.

Still, I was able to endure it.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' yawns lightly.]

The 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is a story about defeating the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

In other words, I was more resistant to the gods of the other world than anyone else in this world.

In fact, the god of this world seemed perplexed when he saw me like that.

But even for a moment.

【My house disappeared a long time ago.】

The terrible storm began to move again. A force that seems to tear me to pieces at any moment.

"Four winds meet to form a direction, and four more winds are added to that direction. It forms the tomb of the eight trigrams."

I slowly closed my eyes and felt the wind blowing.

As if I had become a 'wall'.

As if the story of that wind would be engraved on my body.

I uttered the sentence with all my might, as if I was pressing down to write it.

"Thereby the wind exists everywhere and nowhere."

For an instant, the storm that had been rolling in stopped like magic.

【How do you know that enlightenment?】

Through the storm that was slowly clearing, the appearance of the God of the Other World was revealed.

I smiled as I looked at that guy's story.

"How would I know?"

It seemed like the Wolf Constellation had safely summoned the 'God of the Other World' I mentioned.

However, I was not sure that the 'God of this world' was the 'wolf' of the 'world line' I knew.

Nevertheless, just as Asmodeus came in this 41st round, and just as <Kim Dokja Company> appeared here—if that wolf also overcame the long time and finally became a 'God of Another World'.

Slowly, the wolf with wide eyes approached me.

【No way.】

If I were 'Lee Hakhyun', this gamble would have been impossible.

But now I was acting under the name of 'Kim Dokja'.

If so, there is a possibility.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor is increasing!]

The wolf hurriedly came towards me. Looking at his height, which seems to be about three meters, his first description came to mind again.

「He is about three meters tall. He is a wind fighter with both monster-like stamina and giant-like strength.」

The wolf slowly lowered its gaze towards me. And he looked at me for a long time, as if reading the story buried in my eyes.

【P-Protector? Is it really you?】

He is the 'guide' of the destroyed planet Kronos.

The prince of Imyuntar who taught Kim Dokja the [Way of the Wind].

"It is, Lycaon Isparang."

Kim Dokja once said: It is said that those who make an 'Outer World Covenant covenant of this world' will not be able to see the true ■■.

But in the end, he too made a covenant with another world. He probably couldn't find the answer either. Because this damned world is designed so that no matter what you do, you can't reach the right ■■.

Same goes for me.

"Make an 'Outer World Covenant ' with me."

No matter how much I thought about it, this was the only way to fight against the Zodiac.

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[Some Constellations belonging to the nebula <Zodiac> request a 'probability judgment' regarding the 'Zone 13' incident.]

[Some Constellations belonging to the nebula <Olympus> ask for your permission to enter the 'Recycling Center'.]

[Some Constellations belonging to the nebula <Vedas> ask for your permission to enter the 'Recycling Center'.]

[Some Constellations belonging to the nebula <Tamra>...]

Indirect messages from Constellations pouring in endlessly.

When the Recycling Center director waved his hand in the air as if he was annoyed, the messages scattered like a swarm of insects.

A screen appeared where the messages were scattered.

A screen showing the scenery of Zone 13.

[As you know, I like 'old stories'.]

The head of the Recycling Center smiled as he saw the incarnation and the wolf confronting each other on the screen.

[Seeing that you are moved by that story, it seems that your story has already become an 'old story'.]

As he said that, he looked back at the flask behind him.

Inside a huge flask the size of a person was a man wearing a white coat with his eyes closed.

The Recycling Center director asked, slowly placing his hand on the wall of the flask.

[How many points would you give to that story, Demon King of Salvation?]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 734 Episode 29 Recorder of Fear (1)

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「The universe is a very large secret room. There is a wall at the end of the secret room. We have never touched that wall.」

—Recorder of Fear

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Belonging to the planet Kronos.

Prince of the Imyuntar race and the first wolf—'Lycaon Isparang'.

This wolf, who appears as a guide in the 'fifth scenario' in the main story, was a character whose whereabouts were unknown after clashing with another guide, 'Antinus'.

"Is it really that 'Lycaon'?"

After the identity of the 'God of the Other World' was revealed, the party members expressed their surprise in different ways.

Dansu ahjussi, who could not join in on the surprise, asked hesitantly.

"Who is Lycaon?"

"You know, the guide from the 'Disaster Scenario'. The wolf from the meteorite."

"Oh, that guy… wasn't he dead?"

"There was no mention of his death. His whereabouts became unknown after that."

"Yes. That's true, but…"

Ye Hyunwoo, who was shaking his head at Killer King's words, glanced at me.

"Dokja-ssi, how did you know that 'Lycaon' had become a God of Another World?"

Indeed, I thought Ye Hyunwoo would ask. Even though he has read it less times than the other apostles, he is the most quick-witted.

Ye Hyunwoo even called me 'Dokja-ssi'. That probably means that he expects this answer to be like 'Kim Dokja'.

"I wasn't even sure. It was a gamble."

Not surprisingly, there was no additional setting or follow-up story regarding Lycaon.

There are bound to be characters whose importance decreases as the scenario progresses, and Lycaon was also a character who naturally existed in that way.

However, I did not mention Lycaon as a candidate for 'God of the Other World' without thinking.

"It just occurred to me. Perhaps among the people we know, there are individuals who have evolved into 'Outer Gods'."

Many of the 'Gods of the Other World' in the main story were left without seeing the 'end' of the scenario.

Most of them lose their ego and become 'nameless', but sometimes there are those who maintain their ego outside the scenario and increase their power by becoming Outer Gods.

For example, 'Asmodeus' who appeared in this round was of that type.

So that's what I thought.

Perhaps among the characters who are not fully described in the main story, there may be someone who has become a 'God from Another World'.

"It was a gamble with very low odds."

Ye Hyunwoo was right.

The odds were low.

However, this was the 'Recycling Center', and I thought there was a high possibility that that kind of probability would have a positive effect.

And above all.

"There were two alternatives besides Lycaon."

"Three precautions. As expected of Kim Dokja."

"Who were the other two?"

"As you know, among the gods of another world, there is another being related to 'wolves'."

As I said those words, I looked down at little Yoo Joonghyuk.

Is this because the previous battle was too much?

Or did he get sick from eating dirt? Yoo Joonghyuk was lying on the floor, completely exhausted.

I put a thin blanket over him.

"'Kkoma Yoo Joonghyuk' also appeared in the main story."

The second 'Outer God' I was going to call did not have a story related to 'wolves'.

However, there was a scene in the main story where he was compared to a 'wolf', so I thought it might be possible to call him that.

"Hmm. Do you mean 'King of the Lone Wolves'?"

"But would the 'being' respond to the summons?"

"The probability would have been low. In fact, we haven't even seen him in this Round."

The second 'Outer God' I considered was a 'Secretive Plotter'.

However, the 'Secretive Plotter' had reached his ■ ■ and crossed into a completely different world, so there was no certainty that he would respond to the call.

"Then what about the third?"

"The third is..."

I looked up at the sky. In fact, the third response probability was as low as the second.

The third one was even less related to 'wolves'.

However, this is a world where「a man who eats eight meals a day」is recognized as a 'pig'.

"Wolf ears headband. Do you remember?"

「The man wearing the wolf ears headband may also be recognized as a 'wolf'.」

Ye Hyunwoo, who was thinking about something, opened his mouth.

"Wolf ears? When they went to the amusement park in Oz…"

"Yes, that's right."

In a world where all of Kim Dokja's memories become stories, the story of going to the amusement park with Han Sooyoung would certainly survive as fragments of stories.

[A Constellation whose modifier has not yet been revealed is looking at you.]

Even if he is not a deity from another world, Kim Dokja, who possesses that 'story fragment', exists.

If Kim Dokja is a being with a modifier like the 'Demon King of Salvation'…

['Sub-scenario—The Three Little Pigs' has ended.]

At that moment, a scenario ending message appeared.

[500 recycled coins were obtained as a reward.]

[You have cleared the scenario in a way no one has tried before!]

[Your achievements will transform the very foundation of the scenario!]

[The story 'The Three Little Pigs' loses influence in the <Star Stream>.]

"Ah—"

The surrounding scenery shimmered and the night began to fade.

Only then did my companions' faces brighten one by one, as if they realized it.

The event scenario has been lifted and 'wolves' can no longer threaten us. Because the 'wolf' has just joined our side.

"If we're going to fight the <Zodiac> in the future, we'll need that guy's power."

I looked back at Lycaon, who was standing about ten steps away.

Kyung Sein asked with a slightly frightened expression.

"Is it okay? He's a God from Another World."

"There is nothing to be afraid of as a God from Another World. Even in the main story, they negotiated with a God from Another World."

From earlier, Lycaon had been muttering something at the sky.

Perhaps he is exchanging messages with the Management Bureau regarding the 'Otherworld Covenant', or perhaps he is negotiating with the 'Recycling Center'.

I sighed lightly and looked back at my companions.

"And here. These are the 'masks' we recovered earlier."

One of the main purposes of this 'scenario' was to obtain new 'masks' for the group to use.

"Ah. When did this happen—"

It was a mask obtained from previously deceased wolf incarnations.

"Are you sure you don't mind if we take it?"

When Dansu ahjussi lowered his head as if he was sorry, the other party members also lowered their heads as if they were being shamed.

Kyung Sein said in a trembling voice.

"I-I really couldn’t be of any help."

"No, you all did well."

I slowly looked back at my companions and spoke emphatically.

As the party members who recovered the masks put them on one by one, their bodies, which had been transformed, began to return to their original state.

Instead, faces that reflected the characteristics of their time as prisoners appeared on the surface of the mask.

Kyung Sein is a squirrel.

Dansu ahjussi is a turtle.

Cha Yerin is a snail.

Ye Hyunwoo is a panda.

As expected, the 'mask' seemed to reflect the user's original characteristics.

Then, why am I still thinking, 'I’m free from impunity'? Is there any animal that looks similar?

While the group was breathing a sigh of relief, Killer King, the only one among them who had not lost his mask, approached me.

"By the way, you were lucky this time. You know that."

I nodded and said,

"The 'original owner' of the story did not intervene."

The reason why this「staging」collapsed faster than expected was because the original owner of the story, the 「Pig in a Brick House」, did not help us.

If the 'Pig in a Brick House' had intervened on stage, the fight would not have ended so easily.

Of course, even if that happened, it wasn't the worst.

Even if the 'pig' won and the existing narrative was strengthened, we were fighting on the 'pig' side anyway. Even if I couldn't write a new story, I would have benefited from it in some way.

Anyway, I was curious.

Why didn't the 'Pig in a Brick House' intervene on stage? If I think about it, it was a Constellation that had been watching me from the beginning of the scenarios.

"Ah, ahhh… I know what you guys are doing!"

"We're all going to die! We're all going to die!"

After the scenario was over, the prisoners hiding under the table came out one by one.

"The other Zodiac signs will not forgive Zone 13."

"Why, why are you doing this—"

I smiled bitterly as I looked at the terrified prisoners.

Since I couldn't fill up after the first drink, I didn't have high expectations. Because people who are stuck in this scenario are afraid of change.

But not all incarnations were like that.

The crane owner was looking at me with an expression of disbelief.

"Did you say Kim Dokja…?"

Some stories are unchanging prisons.

A prison that restricts existence to a set frame, repeats the same schedule, and transforms it into mere material.

But the prisoners saw with their own eyes that the prison could be broken.

[Your new 'story' begins to influence 'Zone 13'.]

[The name of 'Kim Dokja' is starting to become known at the 'Recycling Center'!]

That's enough for now.

I stood side by side with Killer King and watched the beastmen for a moment.

"The Demon World scenario would have been similar to this."

"I guess so."

"It’s my favorite scenery."

Before we knew it, Ye Hyunwoo, who had changed his mask, came towards us.

The moment Killer King opened his mouth, his eyes widened as if he was dissatisfied with Hyunwoo standing next to him.

"Inho-ssi. But is it okay? You can continue to work under 'that name'?"

"7th Apostle. This guy is Kim Dokja—"

"I’m asking Cheon Inho now, not Dokja-ssi."

I looked into Ye Hyunwoo’s clever eyes beyond the mask.

Come to think of it, there was once a problem with Ye Hyunwoo over using the name Kim Dokja.

"Are you uncomfortable?"

"No, not really. I admit it now. Inho-ssi is the one closest to that name among us. However."

For a moment, I thought I knew what he was worried about.

The story of the <Star Stream> is more sensitive to names than anything else.

That is, if I were to impersonate Kim Dokja—

"If this continues, all the stories Inho-ssi builds will become 'Kim Dokja’s' stories."

That was a sharp point.

"It’s okay. It was intentional."

"You did that on purpose?"

Actually, I had a crucial reason why I impersonated 'Kim Dokja' when I entered the 'Recycling Center'.

[A new story begins to be recorded under the name of 'Kim Dokja'.]

Along with the message, the newly germinated power of the story floated within me.

The name hasn't been decided yet.

A story that has not been lost.

Still, is it because I am also the 'youngest Kim Dokja'? Part of the story was absorbed into me, but the rest slowly rose upward through the ceiling of the Recycling Center.

[Your story will be shared with your sponsor.]

I felt a small sense of relief as I saw the tail of the story moving away.

Thank god. He's still there.

"A similar thing happened in the demon world. Do you remember?"

"You mean when Kim Dokja impersonated Yoo Joonghyuk?"

All stories have a main character and are written around that main character.

While I am impersonating Kim Dokja, the stories I have accumulated will continue to raise Kim Dokja's status.

The created story will make Kim Dokja's name known, and people will call Kim Dokja's name.

And Kim Dokja will also hear that name.

"Wait a minute, it can’t be—"

"I thought about it for a long time. But no matter how much I thought about it, it seemed like this was the only way."

I liked this 41st round. So I hope this world line does not perish.

However, I know that if I protect this world line, other world lines may be destroyed. A much bigger disaster may occur than what happened in the main story.

But the tragedy has not yet been written and the story continues.

So I can do it.

Just what I need.

「A being who can 'reread' all the endings of this story.」

Someone who can turn my 'square circle' into reality.

"I intend to bring 'The Oldest Dream' on this world line."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 735 Episode 29 Recorder of Fear (2)

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When they first heard my story, my companions seemed to think I was crazy.

I understand.

It might sound strange to suddenly call for 'The Oldest Dream'. So I told them again what had happened.

About the 'Demon King of Salvation' I met—and about his 'Brothers' he told me about.

"So, the story is that there may be another 'Kim Dokja' besides the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

When the smart Ye Hyunwoo stated this premise, Killer King twitched his lips and asked.

"Then how many Kim Dokjas exist?"

"It’s probably divided by modifier."

Then Kyung Sein asked in a voice that showed she could not understand.

"Why did it happen like that? Didn’t Kim Dokja come back in the end?"

"That is..."

I don't know exactly about that part either.

According to my intention, 'Kim Dokja' should have returned to the group at the end of the main story. However, something went wrong along the way, and Kim Dokja's existence was split into modifiers.

The companions put their heads together and thought hard about it.

"Then how many Kim Dokjas are there? Is there even an 'Ugly King'?"

"As expected of a guy who read it less times. That’s not a modifier. And it’s not 'ugly', it’s 'ugliest'."

"Who is the 'Prisoner of the Headband' in this world line?"

"That’s a matter worth thinking about, Yerin."

As I listened to the conversation of my companions, I also thought of Kim Dokja's modifiers in my head.

As far as I know, Kim Dokja's modifiers were a total of four.

The Demon King of Salvation.

Watcher of light and darkness.

Prisoner of the Constrictive Headband.

The Oldest Dream.

Kim Dokja obtained the modifiers through different scenarios.

'Demon King of Salvation' is from 'The 73rd Demon King', 'Watcher of Light and Darkness' is from 'Holy Demon War', and 'Prisoner of the Constrictive Headband' is from 'Journey to the West' scenario.

And the 'Oldest Dream'…

"But if it’s the 'Oldest Dream', wouldn’t he still be watching us?"

It was Dansu ahjussi who asked a very fundamental question.

"The 'Oldest Dream'... if I understand it, isn't it 'Kim Dokja, who watches over all world lines'? I think he's already watching us without even needing to call him."

It was just as ahjussi said.

Ye Hyunwoo asked me.

"Have you ever talked to the 'Oldest Dream'?"

"I already tried it."

When I signed with the 'Demon King of Salvation', I called the 'Oldest Dream'. However, the sparks around only grew stronger, and the 'Oldest dream' did not respond at all.

"Why was there no response? Could it be that the 'Oldest Dream' does not exist…?"

"If this world is the '41st Round' we know, then the 'Oldest Dream' definitely exists, because his incarnation is here."

"Oh, that's right."

The group looked down at little Yoo Joonghyuk, who was sleeping soundly.

The 'Oldest Dream' is Yoo Joonghyuk's sponsor.

So there's no way he doesn't exist.

"Now that I think about it, Yoo Joonghyuk also never received a reply from his sponsor."

If you think about it, it was similar in the main story.

Yoo Joonghyuk did not know who his sponsor was and he had never communicated properly.

That's because the 'Oldest Dream' in this story was Kim Dokja's childhood self.

There was a strong [Fourth Wall] between the two.

So, should the 'Oldest Dream' of this world also be seen as 'Kim Dokja's childhood self'?

"Have you tried any other modifiers? Like Watcher of Light and Dark—"

"I tried it, but the only one that succeeded was 'Demon King of Salvation'."

Then Ye Hyunwoo, who was thinking about something, hesitated and spoke as if confessing.

"Actually, I have tried something similar. When I had accumulated a certain amount of coins, I purchased a 'sponsorship contract' and tried to make a contract with the Demon King of Salvation…"

As expected, Ye Hyunwoo has already tried it.

Since he was still without a sponsor, it was entirely possible.

"It failed. None of Kim Dokja's modifiers, including the 'Demon King of Salvation', responded. But Inho-ssi succeeded in signing a contract with 'Demon King of Salvation'."

At those words, the eyes of my companions simultaneously turned to me.

Ye Hyuwoo continued.

"I think this way. In order to communicate with Kim Dokja in this world line, certain 'conditions' are necessary. And among us, only Inho-ssi meets those 'conditions'."

"I agree."

At this point, I was struggling to tell them that I am related to 49% Kim Dokja.

However, Ye Hyunwoo's expression was a little strange.

"It's embarrassing, but I gave up on the scenario right before Inho-ssi came."

Killer King, who intervened midway, muttered, "That wasn't me," and Cha Yerin glared at him.

Ye Hyunwoo continued his words.

"I didn't give up from the beginning. This place was full of scenarios I'd never read about in the Book of Revelation, but I thought I could do it. I thought my companions were strong enough, too. But."

I couldn't tell what kind of expression Ye Hyunwoo was making through the mask.

However, his sunken eyes vaguely hinted at the despair he must have been experiencing.

"It’s only been a month. Everything fell apart in that one month. I thought I could do half as much, if not as well as the characters in the Book of Revelation…"

I recalled the first time I met Ye Hyunwoo.

Seventh apostle with strong pride.

A reader who has read the entire novel 50 times and who analyzes and predicts the world better than anyone else.

The confidence he had back then was no longer visible in his eyes.

"After entering the center and the team with Pildu-ssi was torn apart, things got even more messy. I realized then. I really am nothing. I can't change this world just by knowing a little bit about the contents of the Book of Revelation. Even hoping to survive. It must be arrogance."

Kyung Sein, Dansu ahjussi, and even Cha Yerin silently lowered their heads and looked down at their toes.

"I felt relieved because I gave up. Maybe there was no need for me to take risks in the first place. Maybe this is my nature. Maybe it would suit me to just chew bamboo all day like a panda."

"Hyunwoo-ssi."

"Inho-ssi."

Ye Hyunwoo, re-dressed in his own panda mask, was looking at me.

"I don’t know if I can call 'The Oldest Dream' using Inho-ssi’s method or not. But even if I can’t find the 'Oldest Dream'…"

Ye Hyunwoo took a deep breath and said.

"From now on, I will call Inho-ssi 'Kim Dokja'. This world needs 'Kim Dokja'."

Cha Yerin nodded her head.

Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi also helped.

"Actually, I thought Inho-ssi resembled Kim Dokja for a long time."

"I agree."

The last person to respond was Killer King.

"That guy was Kim Dokja from the beginning."

"You finally got your wish."

At Kyung Sein’s words, the group burst into light laughter.

Ye Hyunwoo took a step towards me and said, holding out his hand.

"So, Kim Dokja, please promise me. You will definitely see the end of this world with us."

Can I become their 'Kim Dokja'?

Maybe it's the opposite.

I said, extending my hand towards him.

"Rather, I would like to ask you a favor. Please join me in creating the story of 'Kim Dokja'."

I can't do it like Kim Dokja on my own. This is possible only with these people.

The strange Killer King and the cold-hearted Cha Yerin.

Smart Ye Hyunwoo and good Dansu ahjussi. And there must be Kyung Sein.

Only with their help can we see the end of this world.

Thinking like that, I was about to hold Ye Hyunwoo’s hand.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is craving it.]

It felt like an electric current was flowing down my spine.

I reflexively withdrew my hand.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' frowns.]

'No.'

The story was desperately put to rest. Nevertheless, my story continued to shake dangerously.

A terrible hunger was coming.

[Legendary tale 'Heir of the Eternal Name' tells you not to interfere.]

The 「Heir of the Eternal Name」 noticed. That there is a 'fragment of Kim Dokja' that he likes in these readers in front of me.

The story whispered.

「There is only one that can become Kim Dokja.」

'No. These are a no-no.'

「You will regret it.」

In the end, the story stopped talking first. When I looked up, my companions were looking at me with worried expressions.

I opened my mouth to them.

"I will definitely see the ending with all of you."

---

Late afternoon.

Smoke began to rise from every chimney in Zone 13. The incarnations were making food.

Killer King stood on the roof of the brick house and watched the changes in Zone 13.

"I guess I can eat some decent food tonight."

Then Ye Hyunwoo, standing next to him, muttered.

"Yeah."

Over the past month, the two have experienced what Zone 13 is like.

For them, the night in 'Zone 13' was hell. Days of trembling in fear while waiting for the wolf harvester to arrive at any time.

But there was something different about the atmosphere tonight.

The smoke rising from the chimneys was the evidence.

The residents here do not normally cook at night. This is because lighting a fire and using a chimney itself could stimulate the wolves.

Ye Hyunwoo said.

"I’m sorry, Second Apostle."

"What."

"We couldn’t have survived the past month without you."

The person who protected the group in Zone 13 for the past month was Killer King.

If it weren't for him who became a 'wolf' himself and protected his party, his party would never have been able to survive the threat of wolves.

"And…"

Instead of speaking next, Ye Hyunwoo looked down at the empty space below the roof.

In the center of the vacant lot, Cheon Inho was standing face to face with Lycaon and talking.

Ye Hyunwoo opened his mouth.

"You know that Dokja-ssi is hiding something."

Killer King nodded his head.

"Kim Dokja is that kind of guy."

"Have you ever used [Eyes of Sin] on Dokja-ssi?"

「Eyes of Sin.」

The exclusive holy soul of Archangel 'Jophiel' who can identify evildoers.

Killer King nodded his head.

"He was bitter."

"How did it go?"

"At first, he was marked as a villain who killed more than ten people. But something was strange, so I used the stigmata once more and—"

Killer King slowly blinked and recalled his memories from that time.

The day he first met Cheon Inho.

That day, Killer King headed toward Cheon Inho.

[Eyes of Sin was activated twice in total.]

"I couldn’t see anything."

"Nothing?"

"Everything was pure white."

Although the skill ended quickly, Killer King saw the scene clearly. A distant and barren white snowy field spread around Cheon Inho.

"What does that mean? A villain or—"

"I do not know either."

The wind blew intermittently from the open space below the roof.

Cheon Inho was waving his hands in the air as if he was learning the tricks of [The Way of the Wind].

Lycaon was also seen touching his forehead as if something was not going well.

"I guess Kim Dokja is right."

"I guess so."

The two people laughed. As the light laughter dispersed with the wind, Killer King asked this time.

"Are you going to be okay?"

"What?"

"I won’t ask twice."

Ye Hyunwoo smiled bitterly at Killer King’s question.

"There’s nothing to do about whether it’s okay or not. In the first place, I’m the kind of person who can’t play the role of Kim Dokja."

"Not everyone needs to be Kim Dokja. You just have to do what you’re good at. Like me."

Killer King said those last words and jumped down to the roof.

After a while, a loud noise was heard from the vacant lot. Surprisingly, the wind was moving, albeit faintly, at Killer King's fingertips.

Lycaon's small wind elasticity.

Ye Hyunwoo muttered as he looked at Killer King, who was smiling meaningfully.

"You look a little like Yoo Joonghyuk."

Ye Hyunwoo thought that maybe that was why he was so angry.

If that guy was Yoo Joonghyuk, he should have been Kim Dokja more than anyone else.

He should have stood next to the guy, defeated the enemies, compensated for the guy's mistakes, and cleared the scenario confidently.

But he hasn't been able to fulfill that role for the past month.

It was someone else who took on the role of Kim Dokja.

He had similar thoughts during the 'emergency defensive battle' in Chungmuro and when he faced the 'absolute throne' in Gwanghwamun.

He just didn't admit it.

However, as he watched him stage the 'brick house', open the door, and go through the storm, Ye Hyunwoo couldn’t help but admit it.

Kim Dokja of this world is that person.

Above that detached confidence, only one question remained.

So what am I in this world?

"I…"

The moment he unconsciously opened his mouth, a star in the sky looked down at him.

The star, with its extremely ominous light, was asking him.

"Do you want to become the 'real Kim Dokja'?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 736 Episode 29 Recorder of Fear (3)

From the next day, the party participated in the scenario again.

"As expected, wearing a mask makes me feel at ease."

Dansu ahjussi also nodded at Kyung Sein’s words.

"It feels like I was naked and then put on clothes."

I may be wondering how they could feel that way when they only wore a mask, but after actually wearing a mask, the attitudes of my companions changed significantly.

[The character 'Kyung Sein' regains confidence.]

I also felt fortunate that I was wearing a mask. Because I wasn't confident in hiding my expression.

I slowly turned my head and looked at Dansu ahjussi.

[Character information regarding the character 'Lee Dansu' is being updated.]

A cold sensation clung to my spine. I once received a message in Gwanghwamun that Ye Hyunwoo had become a 'character'.

However, following Kyung Sein, now there is even Dansu ahjussi.

What are the standards for 'alternative characterization'? What is the difference between a 'character' and a person who is not a 'character'?

Cha Yerin said.

"Hide in a small story to avoid being eaten by a huge story."

"Yes?"

"There are stories that can only be seen objectively if they are hidden."

A bit late, I realized that it was a story about 'masks'.

I could see prisoners bustling around outside the window.

It was easy to read the facial expressions of all the maskless beastmen. Happy, sad, angry or tired faces.

Now that they have become part of the Recycling Center, they can only make facial expressions enforced by 'Zone 13'.

Kyung Sein muttered as if she was impressed.

"They said everything in the <Star Stream> is a story."

This 'mask' is the minimum narrative that can protect us.

The Recycling Center was informing us now. In order not to be swept away by the big story, you have to keep your own story straight.

Just like Kim Dokja once did.

[You understand the essence of the 'Recycling Center'.]

[Main scenario updated!]

The main scenario was updated as if it had been waiting for it.

I immediately checked the message.

**<Main Scenario #8 – Zone 13>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: S+

Clear conditions: Unite the beastmen of Zone 13 and challenge the throne of the <Zodiac>.

Time limit: 60 days

Reward: Obtain a ticket to attend the Chinese Zodiac Banquet, choose between 300,000 coins or 50,000 recycled coins and obtain the story fragment 'Understanding of the Unemployed'.

Failure: —

* There are 'additional clear conditions' in this scenario.

Kyung Sein, who had confirmed the reward, opened her mouth with joy.

"Zodiac Banquet? Isn’t this something like the 'Constellation Banquet'? I really enjoyed the 'Constellation Banquet' episode."

"Can we see Uriel and Jecheon Castle?"

"This is in the name of the zodiac, so I think only people from the zodiac will come."

Chinese zodiac Banquet.

It was the very event that 'The Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' once mentioned.

I didn't know that it was an event that occurred at the 'Recycling Center'.

If you think about it, this round's <Zodiac> was a bit unusual. Originally, the Constellation of the <Zodiac> was not a group with proper solidarity.

However, in this round, it even has a scenario through a stage called 'Recycling Center'.

In a situation where I don't know what kind of <Zodiac> I will face in the future, the reward for conquering this scenario was quite fascinating.

「'Understanding the Unemployed' is a story fragment that must be acquired in order to confront the <Zodiac>.」

A story fragment that is mentioned in Yoo Joonghyuk's recollection in 'Ways of Survival'.

I must clear this scenario at all costs.

The problem is the clear conditions.

[Check additional clear conditions.]

—You must secure the support of prisoners to challenge the 'unification of Zone 13'.

—When more than 80% of the population supports you, you will be elected as the 'representative' of Zone 13.

—When elected as a district representative, you can form a committee responsible for Zone 13.

[Currently, 9% of prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

"Have you all checked the additional clear conditions?"

In response to Ye Hyunwoo’s question, the group members nodded one by one.

"Should we each tell our approval ratings? It says 3 percent."

"I’m… zero percent."

"It’s one percent."

As Kyung Seun and Dansu ahjussi spoke, Cha Yerin also opened her mouth.

"Two percent."

The last answer was Killer King, who was smiling meaningfully.

"5%. Kim Dokja, what percentage do you have?"

"Nine percent."

Ye Hyunwoo nodded his head.

"The representative will be Dokja-ssi."

---

After 「The Three Little Pigs」, the inn's crane owner changed his attitude towards us. Not only did he not charge us for meals, he even changed our accommodations.

"I don't have anything in particular to wish for."

That's what he said, but the crane owner seemed like he wanted to tell us something every time he saw us.

"If there's anything you want to ask for, please let me know anytime."

The crane owner said with a bitter smile.

"I think you are very brave. Just don't be too disappointed if not everyone is as brave as you."

At his unexpected honesty, I hesitated for a moment and then added.

"It's okay. That's…"

"It was truly an amazing sight when you slaughtered the pig. I'm sure some beastmen were impressed by your performance. There were also others whose hearts were boiling. But."

After a short pause, the owner continued his words.

"Not everyone can do that. The beastmen here will be more afraid of you when they see you."

I didn't understand it at first, but when I thought about it carefully, it made sense.

"Are they afraid of change?"

"It's similar."

"But they can't live like this forever, right? Even with 'The Three Little Pigs'—"

"The prisoners stayed here too long."

They stayed too long.

It was a bit of a feeling of déjà vu.

Was it the demon world? Or was it paradise?

I think Kim Dokja also heard something similar somewhere.

"Not everyone wants to have their own 'mask'."

The owner's voice conveys a strange sense of fatigue. A thought suddenly occurred to me.

Maybe the beastmen here are not afraid of the Zodiac.

Having a mask means building your own story.

They are now afraid of taking responsibility for their own stories.

After quickly devouring the omelet rice made by the chef, I went out to the vacant lot and checked the stories I had accumulated so far one by one.

[A new story is germinating within you.]

Excluding the 'Persistent Murim Master' obtained from Dragon Head Ark, there were a total of four stories that I accumulated on my own.

「Recorder of things that will disappear obtained at Seoul Station.」

「Heir to the Eternal Name obtained after defeating the Deity of the Other World together with Han Sooyoung.」

And 「The One Who Rewrites Fate」 obtained by dealing with the giant nebulae with the Demon King of Salvation.

Lastly, the new story I will get this time.

Since the sponsor contract has already been completed, completing five stories won't suddenly make me a Constellation, but I felt that I had built up stories quite steadily, even compared to Kim Dokja in the main story.

[A new story awaits your new achievements.]

[Additional achievements are required to fully blossom the story.]

It was a message I had never heard before, but it wasn't a bad situation.

Rather good.

The longer it takes for blossoming to occur, the higher the level of the story I obtain. If high-level stories are successfully developed, the name of 'Kim Dokja' will become even more widespread.

[A few Constellations in the nebula <Zodiac> are showing hostility towards you.]

As if they knew that fact, the Constellations of the Chinese zodiac seemed to be keeping me in check.

However, there were no Constellations directly interfering with Zone 13.

I know why they are hesitant to intervene.

【Student.】

It's because of this wolf.

【That’s not how you do it.】

A god from another world who defeated the pig Constellations that activated「Staging」.

Since yesterday, I have been learning [The Way of the Wind] from him.

【I'll show you again.】

「Way of the Wind was Kim Dokja’s main skill.」

Kim Dokja also had a hard time learning this skill.

【I don't understand why you can't do this.】

"Hmm, maybe it’s because I don’t have a charm?"

Originally, [Way of the Wind ] was a skill that only incarnations with the 'Imyuntar Charm' could learn.

However, I have no luck as I did not participate in the 'disaster scenario'.

【Since I am no longer the 'guide' of the scenario, I can teach [Way of the Wind] regardless of whether the charm exists or not.】

"The use of skills is blocked in Zone 13. Maybe that's why I can't learn it—"

【That's why it's being taught in the form of story fragments. Skills are stereotypical surnames, and surnames are refined tales. In other words, if you know how to handle stories, you can use [Way of the Wind] without activating the skill.】

"Okay."

Yes. I am a talentless piece of trash.

【I'll show you again, so follow along carefully.】

Lycaon blinked slowly and took a deep breath.

【A gale in my left hand, a storm in my right hand. Where straight lines and curves collide, the path of the wind will open.】

The fierce wind split before my eyes, truly opening the [Way of the Wind].

Once again, I was amazed.

That's the original [Way of the Wind].

It feels different from what the Demon King of Salvation used.

【Now, try following along. A gale in my left hand.】

I hesitantly followed Lycaon.

"Gale in the left hand."

【Crung! Bigger! A storm in my right hand.】

"In my right hand... a storm!"

【Where straight lines and curves collide, the path of the wind will open! Shout out with some confidence!】

The only people who are okay with reciting lines like this are probably Kim Namwoon or Yoo Joonghyuk. The former is that kind of guy, and the latter is a cool guy no matter what he says.

As neither of the two, I had to mumble like a small octopus.

"Where straight lines and curves collide, the path of the wind will open..."

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' likes 'Way of the Wind'.]

Naturally, [Way of the Wind] was not opened.

Lycaon looked at me blankly and asked.

【Why can’t you do it? I told you everything. again! A gale in your left hand!】

Finally, I couldn't bear it anymore and answered.

"That’s just shouting out words like that."

【No. It is important to understand this 'enlightenment'.】

What kind of enlightenment is there?

【You must understand the meaning contained in the story.】

No, I mean, in a gale and storm, what great meaning does it have?

【Look at them.】

Lycaon pointed to the group of people who, like me, were practicing [Way of the Wind] in an open space about a dozen steps away.

The first person that caught my eye was Cha Yerin.

"Left hand. Gale. Right hand. Storm."

The energy of the wind was rushing from both her hands as she freely chanted the spell.

Although it was not as grand as Lycaon's, it was definitely the [Way of the Wind].

【Incredible! Oh, she is a very outstanding incarnation. She truly understands the nature of the wind.】

For reference, it only took 30 minutes for Cha Yerin to learn [Way of the Wind].

I was curious about the secret and asked, and Cha Yerin answered as follows.

"I just… just did it and it worked."

There are just geniuses in this world.

I gave up trying to figure out the secret and looked back at the other group members.

The man who had been repeatedly clenching and unclenching his fist in a corner from earlier said with a light sigh.

"As I get older, it's not easy to learn new things."

For your reference, Dansu ahjussi succeeded in learning [Way of the Wind] in five hours.

Kyung Sein, who was practicing [Way of the Wind] next to him, also added a word.

"You have too much humility. You learned an hour faster than me…"

"Hmm, that's what Kim Dokja said. In this world, age and gender don't matter."

"Wow, you remember that too."

"I actually have a good memory."

I doubt whether that person is really Dansu ahjussi who mistook Sneaky Schemer for Secretive Plotter.

"Anyway, Hyunwoo is late."

"He went out scouting to test the Way of the Wind, so why not come back around evening?"

Ye Hyunwoo, who had mastered [Way of the Wind] early on, was also flying around Zone 13.

For reference, it took 3 hours for Ye Hyunwoo to get his first wind.

Among the group, he had the second best score after Cha Yerin.

"Kim Dokja, could it be that you still haven’t mastered [Way of the Wind]?"

I grinned at Killer King, who was approaching me sloppily. I never thought the day would come when I would be happy to see that face.

"Killer King-ssi, didn’t you learn it too?"

"What nonsense? I mastered it right away."

Killer King, with a confident expression on his face, spread his hands wide and shouted loudly.

"A gale in my left hand! A storm in my right hand!"

When I thought about it, there were people other than Kim Namwoon and Yoo Joonghyuk who could confidently shout that spell.

"…The way of the wind will open!"

I felt a slight wind moving along with the spell.

I asked while looking at Killer King.

"Isn’t that just clapping your hands quickly?"

"The training stops at this point, I have learned everything about [Way of the Wind]."

No matter how you looked at it, it was the back of a person who had given up and was running away. Lycaon, who was watching Killer King from afar, muttered in admiration.

【It was successful.】

"That was a success?"

【It's faint, but I can feel the texture of the wind. You really are a great hard worker. That's impressive. But No matter how I look at it, I don't think you understand the gist of 'Way of the Wind' at all...】

Suddenly, I became the only person who couldn't learn [Way of the Wind].

Still, I didn't feel too bad.

I saw the group of people lined up laughing and talking, and then I saw little Yoo Joonghyuk sleeping leisurely on the bench.

Behind them stood our little brick house. Although it wasn't as big of a house as Kim Dokja Company wanted to live in, it was still our first house.

【Student.】

"Yes."

【Even if you are reincarnated, you are still the same.】

Shortly after being summoned, Lycaon realized that I was the reincarnation of Kim Dokja.

It was natural.

Because he is a 'god from another world'.

Lycaon must have quickly realized that the story I had was different from the 'Kim Dokja' he remembered.

Nevertheless, Lycaon did not change his attitude toward me. Even though he didn't have a 'favorite friend' and couldn't recall any memories with him, he still treated me as the 'Kim Dokja' he knew.

Perhaps it was not me, but his courtesy to the story left behind by the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"I'm sorry. I thought it would be easy this time since I learned it in my previous life, but I guess I'm not talented."

Lycaon looked at me with strange eyes.

An expression that seems sympathetic, lonely, or quietly observing.

【Even in your previous life, student never learned any skills. Even though you've used it before.】

"Well... I did."

I also want to steal it, but damn, I don't have [bookmark].

【Does student know why he can't learn [Way of the Wind]?】

"Hmm."

I thought of a sentence about [Way of the Wind] in my head.

「'When one wind meets another wind, it forms Taegeuk, and when one wind meets another wind, it forms yin and yang.'」

It is explained in 'Ways of Survival', and [Way of the Wind] read again by Kim Dokja.

"'Four winds meet to form a direction, and then four more winds are added to form the Myo of the Eight Trigrams. As a result, the wind exists everywhere and nowhere.'"

I remembered every single sentence about it.

Maybe that's where the problem lies.

【You are a being that cannot understand [Way of the Wind]. To be more precise—】

Some understanding comes only when you let go of what you know.

But I can't do that.

【It seems that [Way of the Wind] has already been 'recorded' in you.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 737 Episode 29 Recorder of Fear (4)

「For me, [Way of the Wind] has already been recorded.」

I wondered what that meant.

Since I am also a part of Kim Dokja, does this mean that Kim Dokja's story is sleeping within me?

Kim Dokja had no talent for anything else, but he had a talent for storytelling.

Even when the 'Demon King of Salvation' descended on me, he used that talent to fight.

Then why can’t I use [Way of the Wind]?

Several hypotheses came to mind, but the most reliable way to verify them was to ask the person making the statement directly.

"What does that mean?"

Lycaon, who had been groaning, slowly opened his mouth.

**【■■■ ■…】**

A strong spark flew out along with the sound of Tsutsutsu. Lycaon frowned.

Is this filtering as expected? I wondered when information I couldn't hear would come out.

Perhaps it is related to the end of this world line. I don’t know how Lycaon knows that information, but…

Lycaon thought for a moment and said this.

【Student. It is reading records that have not yet been written. I could tell you, but now is not the time.】

To put it simply, it goes against probability.

【As you know, the very fact that I am here now is against probability.】

Not yet now. In the sky, the Constellations of the Chinese zodiac were gathering together to hold a contest.

[Some Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Zodiac> are asking why that wolf does not return to the other world.]

[Some Constellations from the Nebula <Zodiac> request a 'probability suitability judgment'.]

[Some of the Constellations of the Nebula <Zodiac> question whether it makes sense for an 'Outer God' to intervene in the scenario.]

[The Bureau is currently reviewing the matter.]

System messages emerging in real time.

But I wasn't particularly shaken or embarrassed.

[The Dokkaebi 'Bihyung' admits that the existence of the Outer God is probable.]

[Some Constellations in the Nebula <Zodiac> question whether that makes sense.]

[The Management Bureau certifies that there is no problem in the matter.]

This was because Lycaon’s current existence did not conflict with the probability of <Star Stream>.

[A few Constellations in the Nebula <Zodiac> are puzzled by the Management Bureau's judgment.]

It must be embarrassing for the Constellations.

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' is observing you with curious eyes.]

If you think about common sense, their decision was right. Regardless of the status of the 'God of the Other World', it was improbable that the 'God of the Other World' existed in only the eighth scenario.

But they won't know.

What kind of 'covenant' did Lycaon and I make?

[You have currently entered into an Outer World covenant with the 'Lost Guide'.]

A lost guide.

That was the pseudonym of 'Lycaon Isparang', who became the god of another world.

[The 'Otherworld Covenant' you currently have with the 'Lost Guide' is as follows.]

* The 'Lost Guide', a deity from another world, stays in 'Zone 13' of the Recycling Center for a total of 30 days based on the 'lower floor of the Recycling Center'.

* During the residency period, the 'Lost Guide' will not directly interfere with the scenario.

* The 'Lost Guide' will not protect you during your residency.

* While the 'Lost Guide' resides in the area, you must supply him with the story of「The Three Little Pigs」in return.

* The 'Lost Guide' can teach you and your companions [Way of the Wind] during your stay.

* Even if you do not master [Way of the Wind], the 'Lost Guide' does not take any responsibility for this.

This was the entire 'Otherworld Covenant' I made with Lycaon.

The summary of the contract was as follows.

「For the next 30 days, Lycaon will exist as a 'wind doll' next to me.」

Aside from being able to teach me the [Way of the Wind], he can't help me at all, and he doesn't even protect me when the Constellations attack.

In fact, at the time of signing the contract, Lycaon asked this question.

—Student… Are you really a fanatic?

I answered with a grin.

"Anyway, it would be impossible to conclude a contract with other details."

Around the eighth scenario, I started to see something.

There are limits to the 'otherworldly covenant' that can be made in a scenario of this scale.

—Student will gain nothing by proceeding with this covenant. Considering student's talent, even learning the [Way of the Wind] is not guaranteed...

"It is a condition that was intentionally put in place. The more unfavorable the terms of the covenant are, the higher the probability that it will not go against probability."

If you just read the contents, I really could have gained nothing from this covenant and ended up only losing my stake in the story.

But it wasn't really that bad.

"Instead, this condition must never be made known to the Constellations."

Because that was the core of this 'otherworldly covenant'.

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' realizes your trick and is amazed.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon of the Abyss' asks what is going on.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' says it's not fun to say that.]

It seems like Waryong noticed, but it doesn't matter.

They can visit the 'Recycling Center' because 'dragon' is included in their modifier, but they will not interfere with the work of the <Zodiac>.

[Some Constellations from the Nebula <Zodiac> are targeting the 'Lost Guide'.]

Lycaon, who had been silently receiving the Constellations' gaze, opened his mouth as if he belatedly realized something.

【Student is still the same even if you are reincarnated. You are truly an exceptionally cowardly person.】

"I often hear compliments like that."

My strategy is simple.

「Put up a ‘wind doll’ next to me, but don’t let anyone know it’s a 'wind doll'.」

【The covenant could have failed. Weren’t you afraid?】

Even if it was an 'otherworldly covenant' with unfavorable conditions, if the Dokkaebi in charge was a guy like 'Paul', my plan could have gone wrong.

"I thought it wouldn’t fail."

I knew right away that it was a local Dokkaebi. And above all, this scenario area was the 'Recycling Center'.

[The 'Recycling Center Director' is interested in your scheme.]

Since the name was 'Recycling Center', I believed that the center director would not abandon the 'God of the Other World'. Because the gods of the other world are the ones who need 'recycling' more than any other material in this universe.

[Some Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Zodiac> disobey the management’s judgment…]

It may seem noisy on the outside, but the cowardly Constellations of the Chinese zodiac will not be able to interfere with Zone 13 for 30 days.

The group who had been practicing [Way of the Wind] returned to their lodgings one by one, and the sun began to set in Zone 13.

I opened my mouth as I noticed that the Constellations from the Chinese Zodiac, who were venting their anger in the dark sky, were disappearing one by one.

"Lycaon. Let’s talk about the past for a moment."

I thought it was time to bring up that story.

I was curious about other things, too, but I also wanted to know what happened to Lycaon.

As far as I know, Lycaon went missing around the time the 'Disasters of Floods' descended.

But how was it possible for Lycaon to become a 'God From Another World' and descend to this world line?

【That...】

If we figure out how he did that, we might be able to get clues about other enemies that exist in this world line.

"Is that also a record that hasn’t been written yet?"

Lycaon seemed to think about it for a moment, but then he opened his mouth.

【It's not a very interesting record, but if you don't mind.】

---

The story returns to the 'Disaster Scenario', the fifth scenario of the 1,864th round.

At that time, Lycaon was swept away by the explosion of the 'Disaster of Questions' while fighting with Antinus, the 'Queen of the Parasites', another guide.

Lycaon, who lost consciousness, was mentally controlled by Antinus and was liberated after meeting Lee Gilyoung.

「"This is the first time I've seen a bug like you! "」

After 'Antinus' was eliminated by Lee Gilyoung, Lycaon's body began to die.

「The 'Guide' cannot bear the power of a disaster.」

It was due to the aftereffects of the explosion of the 'catastrophe meteorite'. The durability of his body had reached its limit, but Lycaon struggled to survive somehow.

「Your tale responds to your will.」

As a result, Lycaon entered a new evolution. He had succeeded in taking a leap forward from being a '5th grade alien species'.

「The new skill 'Restorative Predation' has been acquired.」

[Restorative Predation, which eats the bodies of other monster species and revitalizes their incarnation bodies.]

Just then, the 'Flood Disaster' began and the [Monster Gate] opened, and he was able to survive by eating the bodies of dead monsters.

However, the wounds received from the 'disaster' were not easily healed.

【When I fully recovered, student had already entered the ninth scenario area.】

Ninth scenario, 'Dark Castle'.

【I also followed student into the Dark Castle.】

"You were in the Dark Castle?"

【Yes.】

However, nowhere in 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 was there any information that Lycaon was there.

Did Han Sooyoung omit that information?

【I only had a chance to meet student once...】

"When?"

【When student fought the 'Dream Eater', student couldn't see me, but I saw student.】

Memories came to mind again and again.

The Dark Castle's 2nd floor. To save his mother Lee Sookyung, Kim Dokja fought alongside Yoo Joonghyuk against the 'Dream Eater'.

【Even now, the student of those days is vivid in my eyes.】

Lycaon's eyes twinkled dimly.

【Some stories, regardless of their level, sometimes captivate your being just by watching them. If you are someone like me who doesn't have your own ■■, you are even more vulnerable to it.】

Under the dazzling light of the mortal stars, Lycaon made a decision.

【I thought that since student gave me enlightenment, I should also repay my debt.】

"Wait a minute, no way."

【Yes. When student was swallowed up by the 'Dream Eater', I also entered into it.】

"Did you meet Kim Dokja there?"

【No, unfortunately I couldn't meet student. This is because the 'Dream Eater's' stomach was too wide.】

The 'Dream Eater' is a powerful deity from another world.

Its stomach was so large that it was located outside of outer space.

So, it was not strange that Lycaon and Kim Dokja could not meet.

"But the 'Dream Eater' would have died in the end. No, not exactly—"

If I remember correctly, the 'Dream Eater' is eventually absorbed into the [Fourth Wall] and becomes a librarian at the library.

However, Lycaon was inside the stomach of such a 'Dream Eater'.

【Yes. That was the problem. That's where the story gets a little complicated. I was trapped in the stomach of the 'Dream Eater' who was eaten by the [Fourth Wall].】

"No, what…"

It was harsh. While trying to save Kim Dokja, he got trapped in the stomach of an Outer God.

【I was trapped inside for a very long time.】

"…Sorry."

【I don't know why you're apologizing, but it wasn't a very bad time. I was able to watch your story through the tales read by the 'Dream Eater'.】

Only then did I understand.

The reason why he knows the story of Kim Dokja that he could never know.

"How long have you been there?"

【Until student saw the '■■' of everything.】

"Then after that…"

【The 'Dream Eater' realized my existence too late and released me.】

When he was released, the world line's scenarios had ended.

The bureau collapsed and the story that bound him disappeared.

He, who had been the 'guide' of the scenario, was no longer given a role. And the fate of those who lost their role in this world was determined.

【It was an empty but common ending.】

Most beings in this world die without even finding out what their ■■ is, let alone reaching it.

Lycaon suffered the same fate.

【If only I hadn't met that being.】

There was someone who took care of the dying Lycaon.

He exists outside of the scenarios.

「Like the 'Oldest Dream'.」

There Lycaon met one of the 'Great Old Ones'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

# 738 Episode 29 Recorder of Fear (5)

Great Old One.

There were names that came to mind the moment I heard them.

"Who was it?"

The 'Great Old Ones' are probably the highest level 'Gods of the Other World' or those who are considered the kings of the 'Gods of the Other World'.

'Secretive Plotter' was an example—or the incarnations who saw the end of the world in the 999th Round.

However, at the end of the 1,864th Round, the 'Secret Plotter' and the 999th Round's gods met the 'Oldest Dream' and disappeared after ■■.

There is no reason to come back to save Lycaon.

So, apart from them, are there more 'Great Old Ones'?

【Student, I can't talk about it carelessly.】

I thought so.

I asked back while roughly predicting the reason.

"Why?"

【When I utter that name, the 'Great Old One' will also recognize you.】

In this world, a name is a coordinate.

There was a similar reason why it was considered taboo to call someone by their true name.

"Still, if I want to hear it?"

【Sorry.】

"Is even a hint difficult?"

【Yes, sorry.】

I shook my head to show that it was okay.

In fact, the stories I heard from Lycaon so far were quite high-quality information. In particular, the story about the 1,864th round is not strange even if it is filtered along the way.

Nevertheless, the fact that no filtering occurred proves two facts.

First, in this world line, the 'scenario progression speed' is that fast.

Two, there are people other than me who are curious about this story right now.

[The 'Recycling Center Director' listens to your story with interest.]

"What is certain is that the 'Great Old One' has brought you back to life. So what is his mission for you?"

I thought this could also be a secret, but unexpectedly Lycaon answered obediently.

【Collecting 'records' of twisted world lines.】

'Twisted World Line' and 'Record'.

The moment I heard those two words, something came to mind.

Lycaon made eye contact with me and slowly nodded.

【In the world, people like me are called 'Recorders of Fear'. I am the lowest among them.】

Recorder of Fear.

I knew we would meet at least one, but I never thought it would be 'Lycaon'.

There was more than one thing I wanted to ask.

What exactly do 'Recorders of Fear' do?

What do you know about this world line?

Does the 'twisted world line' he is talking about refer to this round?

Why are you still active after everything ■■

is over…?

【Student.】

Lycaon looked at me for a moment as if he understood all my questions, and then closed his eyes.

【Sorry, but I will sleep a little.】

"Yes?"

【I guess I said too much.】

Since when did the concentration of sparks floating around Lycaon become thicker?

The 'otherworldly covenant' that Lycaon made with me is to exist in Zone 13 for 30 days.

In other words, Lycaon had no right to answer my questions.

In such a situation, the probability was about to become dangerous because he was telling me stories about other world lines.

Just before closing his eyes, Lycaon added.

【Be careful, student. This world line is one of the 'unknown beginnings'.】

It was a voice filled with gentle concern.

【Many 'Old Beings' are watching your choices. According to your choice—】

Pushushushu, I heard the sound of wind falling from somewhere. At the same time, Lycaon's body rapidly became smaller. Eventually Lycaon, who had grown to the size of a dog, sat cross-legged and closed his eyes. He seemed to have entered a temporary state of probability conservation.

[The 'Recycling Center Director' looks disappointed.]

I was equally disappointed, but it would have been difficult if Lycaon had been canceled here.

This is because Lycaon’s presence is absolutely necessary for this scenario to go according to my plan.

In any case, I also found out that Lycaon was a 'Recorder of Fear', so it was not without gains.

To soothe my worries, I began practicing the [Way of the Wind] taught by Lycaon again.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is starving.]

[Currently, you have 9 days left to live.]

There is still time.

---

The next day, and the day after that.

My companions and I continued to practice [Way of the Wind].

But no matter how much I practiced, the wind did not come out of my hands.

「It seems that [Way of the Wind] has already been recorded in student.」

What did Lycaon mean by those words?

If [Way of the Wind] is recorded in me, why can't I use this power?

"You’re so eager."

It was the voice of little Yoo Joonghyuk. He was in a state of fainting right after「The Three Little Pigs」, but it seemed like he had finally woken up from a long sleep.

"Are you awake?"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk nodded and slowly approached me.

Looking closely, it seems a bit difficult to call him a 'kid' now. Perhaps it was because he had grown taller while he was sleeping, but Yoo Joonghyuk had become a full-fledged boy.

I never thought I would be watching Yoo Joonghyuk's growth process in real time.

"I had a strange dream."

As he said those words, the boy Yoo Joonghyuk wiped his mouth. When I saw the crumbling dirt, something occurred to me later.

「"You bastard, you made me suffer, right?"」

Boy, did you really decide to believe it was a dream?

While it was absurd, I also thought it was a good thing. If Yoo Joonghyuk grows up to be an adult with memories of eating dirt, my life will be in danger.

"[Way of the Wind] isn't like that."

"Yeah. I've heard this a lot already."

Yoo Joonghyuk, standing next to me while I was grumbling, wiggled his small hands and tried to do something.

"Do it like this."

A refreshing breeze blew from the boy's fingertips.

It was definitely [Way of the Wind].

This [Way of the Wind] is different from Lycaon's wind and the wind of the Demon King of Salvation.

I smiled bitterly as I looked across the strangely lonely and dreary path of wind.

After all, the main character is the main character.

By the 41st round, is it possible to lightly imitate fragments of these stories?

"Unfortunately, I don’t have any talent."

"I saw you communicating with fragments of the Brick House’s story. This technique is the same. You just have to read the wind like you would understand a brick house."

It's easy to say, but a brick house and wind are different.

The boy, Yoo Joonghyuk, added as if he could read my thoughts.

"The shape of 'wind' that people think of is different. It is important to specify the wind you believe in."

The 'wind' I believe in.

I imagined the image of the wind in my head. Still, I once lived with the title of writer, but the image of wind rarely came to mind.

"I will teach you special enlightenment. In my left hand, I hold a gale—"

"A storm in your right hand. That’s not enlightenment."

"You already knew."

"I can tell you more?"

I recited the [Way of the Wind] spells I knew.

The boy Yoo Joonghyuk's expression changed every moment. At first he seemed surprised, then he showed interest, and at the end he had a sad look in his eyes.

"I see. You know too much."

"Isn’t the more you know the better?"

"You don’t need to know that much."

"Yes, people who can learn everything easily don’t need to know much—"

"I don’t learn everything easily either."

"You can use [Transmission], right?"

「Transmission. With that special skill, Yoo Joonghyuk has endured the world of Ways of Survival, inheriting the abilities of 'last round' several times.」

Yoo Joonghyuk seemed a little surprised that I knew that, but then he shook his head and said,

"[Transmission] just changes the starting point slightly."

It was indeed a remark like being born with a silver spoon in your mouth.

"You don’t realize that having a different starting point from others is a huge benefit."

"It’s probably true the first time. But as the number of rounds increases, it becomes more difficult to catch up with the Constellations."

"That can’t be right."

It was something I didn't understand.

Accumulating rounds means that the total amount of accumulated experience increases. You will learn more about how to become stronger, and you will naturally realize the shortcuts to reaching a certain level.

But as the rounds accumulate, it becomes more difficult to catch up with the Constellations?

"Do you know about the 'Transcendental Sea'?"

"A 'ladder' that mortals can choose to ascend to stars and power."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded his head.

"The first step to transcendence is to go beyond the limits of the body."

I know.

Reach 100 overall abilities and overcome your physical limitations.

"The second process is 'training all skills to their limit'."

"That’s right. As expected, you know a lot."

"It’s just a matter of knowing."

If it seemed like everyone could transcend, the world would be overflowing with Transcendents.

Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth again.

"And the final step is—"

"Forget everything you’ve built up and find your own path."

Forgetting skills, forgetting levels.

Forgetting the numerous 'universal' paths presented by the system and finding your own story.

That was the methodology of 'transcendence' defined by the Breaking the Sky Swordsman.

However, her disciple seemed to have annotations to add to this methodology.

"The final process of transcendence is special, because the 'transcendence' process of finding one’s own story requires enlightenment every time."

"Isn’t it easy for you? Because you have an insight from before."

"It seems you don’t know what enlightenment is."

If you think about it, there is a reason why 'enlightenment' is 'enlightenment'. It is enlightenment because you gain insight into something you did not know before.

"It is impossible to transcend twice with one enlightenment."

It was a worry that other Transcendents did not need to worry about. Because they don't regress.

But Yoo Joonghyuk is different.

Yoo Joonghyuk, whose level is reset at the start of each round, had to gain new enlightenment and reach 'transcendence' each time.

"It's not difficult at first. Once, twice, three times. You can gain as much new enlightenment as you want. But ten, twenty times, when the realizations start to

accumulate, the problem becomes complicated."

Now that I think about it, Yoo Joonghyuk in 'Ways of Survival' did not always transcend at the same time.

There were times when he transcended a little early or a little late.

Could it be that it was because of this?

"If enlightenment accumulates more than 1,800 times, transcendence will become almost impossible."

"What nonsense? There is no reason for so much enlightenment to accumulate."

"Of course it won't."

Respect to you, Secretive Plotter.

"So, what did you do when transcendence became difficult?"

"Initially I tried to somehow find new enlightenment. But as time passed, I realized that it was impossible."

"That too is enlightenment. You must have achieved transcendence once through that."

I thought it was a joke and threw it out, but Yoo Joonghyuk didn't laugh.

Instead, he answered:

"From then on, I forgot what I already knew."

"Do you forget that?"

"Sometimes you forget when you hit your head with [Hundred Steps Godly Fists]."

I couldn't tell if it was a joke or not. Because with Yoo Joonghyuk it really felt like that could happen.

"Anyway, when enlightenment disappears, you just have to fill its place with new enlightenment."

The so-called 'overwriting' of enlightenment.

It was a story that had never been mentioned in detail in 'Ways of Survival'.

"Some enlightenments can only be realized properly if you forget them."

It was somewhat of a touching story.

If it weren't for the part where he hit his head.

"Are you telling me to forget the [Way of the Wind] that I know?"

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded and took the [Hundred Steps Godly Fists] stance and glared at my head.

I hurriedly waved my hand and backed away.

"No, wait a minute! I don’t want to forget anything right now."

"It looks like you’re not that desperate. Is there no reason you need to learn [Way of the Wind]?"

The reason why I want to learn [Way of the Wind].

"I..."

There was a face that came to mind reflexively. A star who sacrificed himself for me.

I had to become stronger.

Just as much, or even more, I had to become strong enough to save him.

This was only possible if Kim Dokja, more than anyone else, did it.

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly lowered his fist and continued speaking.

"There’s no need to force yourself to learn something you’re not good at. There’s probably something you’re good at."

I didn't know that I would hear such a story from Yoo Joonghyuk's mouth, so I stood there in silence for a long time.

"Thank you for the advice."

Stars shed intermittent light in the lonely night sky.

The boy Yoo Joonghyuk stared at the sky for a moment. However, he soon turned his gaze to the ground and asked as if there was no starlight in the sky he was looking for.

"So, what do you plan to do next?"

"We have to get the support of the prisoners."

"Do you think you will gain support from the beasts if you learn things like [Way of the Wind] here?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me as if I was pitiful. It seemed that this time it was my turn to give him new insight.

"How long do you think the prisoners here have stayed here?"

"That..."

The temporal density in the 'Recycling Center' is much higher than in the outside world. Perhaps there are prisoners who have spent decades or over a hundred years here.

"Judging by the atmosphere of the city, it must have been a very long period of time. There must have been several revolutions."

Zone 13 is where prisoners who could not enter the Zodiac gather.

Has there never been a revolution in a place like that? Whether it's a crane, a wolf, a turtle, or a squirrel. Anyone would have resisted the <Zodiac> at least once.

Maybe twice, or three times.

There will be prisoners who fight back just as Yoo Joonghyuk challenges transcendence.

But.

"Probably everyone was affected by the Chinese Zodiac."

The revolution failed. It was natural. Because they were not Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Then one day."

I continued speaking as if at the beginning of a fairy tale.

"These guys who suddenly appeared shattered the existing 'story' and took down one of the <Zodiac Signs>."

The prisoners must have been surprised. To be precise, they were surprised, but I guess it was just surprise.

As the crane owner said, they had been in 'Zone 13' for too long.

"The prisoners must have thought that this would just be a temporary thing. Those guys lounging around in Zone 13 would soon be killed by the other Zodiac animals. Just like they have been doing up until now."

The prisoners will think.

Another member of the <Zodiac> will come soon.

The owners of the story will return to drive out those who believe they are the main characters.

"But no matter how much time passes, what if no one from the Chinese Zodiac comes to harm them? What if not even a shadow of the Chinese Zodiac can be seen, let alone the <Zodiac>?"

"You, you can’t—"

Slowly, Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes grew bigger.

I asked with a grin.

"What are the prisoners thinking now?"

It was then that I heard someone shouting in the dark.

Elongated animal shadows cast between the streetlights.

It wasn't just one or two.

A nervous Yoo Joonghyuk stood next to me in the [Hundred Steps Godly Fists] stance.

But I wasn't particularly nervous.

A voice flowed through the elongated shadows.

"You-all."

The owner of the shadow was the crane owner and other animals who stayed at the inn.

Everyone who witnessed our「Three Little Pigs」.

"Can you change other 'stories' as well?"

I nodded.

[Your approval rating increases.]

[Currently, 10% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

It was time to do what I was good at.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 739 Episode 30 Zodiac (1)

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「The essence of the Chinese zodiac lies in the creation and destruction of all things, and this means that it does not represent any animal.」

—『Understanding the Unemployed』

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After the scenario began, most people stayed up all night with their eyes wide open.

A situation where you never know when and where a monster or enemy will appear.

Fatigue can be alleviated by consuming 'Elaine Forest Spirit' or restorative medicine, so there was no need to take risks unless there was a sleep penalty.

A world where sleep has become a luxury.

In that sense, all incarnations living out the scenario had lost their dreams.

The same was true for the incarnations in front of me right now.

The prisoner, who had been trapped in the prison of a scenario for a long time and had forgotten to dream, asked.

"A-are you really going to change the story?"

The crane owner looked at me with a nervous expression.

"I can change it for you."

"If the <Zodiac> finds out..."

"The <Zodiac> can’t come."

I pointed to the entrance of the inn with my chin. Lycaon was sitting there, cross-legged, with his eyes closed.

Several beastmen looked at each other and nodded.

They also confirmed Lycaon's power. There was no fear of not believing what I said.

"What story can I change?"

"That is…"

“Is it 'The Fox and the Crane'?"

"How did you know?"

How do I know? There is nothing to do.

[The story 'The Fox and the Crane' has been discontinued.]

This is because after repairing the story fragment 「Brick House」, I could gradually see the flow of stories floating around this 'Zone 13'.

The crane owner sighed lightly and opened his mouth again.

"Recently, the status of my story has become unstable."

In order for a 'story' to maintain its original function, the actual owner of the story must be continuously active in the <Star Stream>, or the story must be continuously talked about.

"So, I tried to tell the story through a 'staging', but I couldn’t stage it on my own."

I guess so. That's because the story isn't just about the crane.

"Are there no foxes in Zone 13?"

The crane owner nodded his head with a sigh.

"There used to be one, but the last fox disappeared a few months ago."

"What happened to the last fox?"

"We stopped hearing from him after he was captured by the Zodiac."

<Zodiac>.

It was obvious why they did what they did.

[The presence of the story 'The Fox and the Crane' opens up.]

This is probably because it would be difficult if someone who has built up a legend in Zone 13 threatens their position.

I slowly looked around at the beastmen.

Perhaps some of these were Constellations, like the 'wolf' in 「The Three Little Pigs」, or were beings that came close to being Constellations.

It's just that as time goes by, they lose their own story and their original status.

The owner muttered in a weak voice.

"The fox is probably dead."

Perhaps that's what the 'story' said.

Because he and the fox are tied together by stories.

"At first, I thought about disposing of the stories in the <Zodiac>. If I hand over the stories there, even if the stories are deformed, their status will be maintained."

I thought of the wolf Constellation struggling to maintain 「The Three Little Pigs」.

"But I couldn’t do that. I didn’t want to bow down to the guys who captured the fox, even if it meant losing the story."

The owner lowered his head as he said that.

"I know that I have to let go of the story now. It’s a story I can’t protect alone, and it’s not particularly important to the <Star Stream>. But…"

A strange desire was shining in the eyes of the crane owner who slowly raised his head.

"I thought you might have a way."

I nodded.

"There is a way."

"Really?"

A scenario message suddenly appeared before my eyes.

It's probably a scenario initiated by the 'Recycling Center Director' or the management bureau who was watching the situation.

[A new sub-scenario has arrived!]

**<Sub Scenario – The Fox and the Crane>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: C

Clear condition: Succeed in reproducing the story 『The Fox and the Crane』.

Time limit: —

Reward: 12,000 recycled coins or 2,000 recycled coins and an unidentified story fragment

Failure: —

The situation was different from the time of 「The Three Little Pigs」. Since the situation did not specifically involve the <Zodiac>, there was no hesitation in participating on stage.

The problem is finding a role to play the role of a 'fox'.

Killer King raised his hand.

"I will do it."

"Killer King-ssi is a wolf."

"Just change it to wolves and cranes."

"If we want to make a staging, we need a fox."

However, no one in our group had a 'fox mask'.

Fox, fox.

It would be nice to have a story similar to 'Fox'.

Oh, wait a minute.

[Check the delayed 'compensation list'.]

Now that I think about it, there was a 'story reward' that I had not received yet.

[Check the rewards for the seventh main scenario.]

[Currently, 'S-class skill selection' is waiting to be received.]

[Currently, 'historical-grade story selection' is waiting to be received.]

Even if it's 'S-level skill selection', 'historical-grade story selection'?

I guess this wasn't the original scenario reward?

[You have achieved an impossible feat in the seventh main scenario.]

[The Bureau recognizes your achievements.]

[The scenario reward 'random historical-grade story' has been upgraded to ‘historical-grade story selection'.]

The management bureau did something helpful for the first time in a while.

Well, considering what happened at the Washington Dome, upward payment is quite possible.

By the way, it is a historical-grade story selection.

Historical-grade stories are mostly trash, but there are some useful ones, such as 「The Persistent Murim Master」.

There are also things that display processing abilities when fused, such as 「earrings when worn on the ear」 or 「nose rings when worn on the nose」.

I checked the reward list with some anticipation.

[Check the list of historical-grade story rewards.]

[You can choose one of a total of 461 stories.]

461.

Could it be that some of this is useful?

1. Poop pretending to be soybean paste

2. Cat with tanned whiskers

3. Silla-Tang Allied Forces

…

For some reason, all I could see were lame stories.

There is also a story that would have happened if the Demon King of Salvation was next to me.

I continued to look at the stories.

Number 10, Number 30, Number 50, Number 100..

122. I'm not getting my hair cut.

123. Head Shoulders Knees Toes

124. A chef who can't distinguish between salt and sugar

125. Ornamental Beard Specialist

Occasionally, stories that seemed to come from the 'Random Story Box' were also seen.

As the ranks passed the 200th, and even the 300th mark, an ominous feeling slowly came over me.

No matter how I looked at it, it seemed like they had just picked up and collected stories discarded by other Constellations.

There were even stories like 「Earrings on your ears」.

The moment when I finally felt resigned to whether or not I should give up.

461. Owner of the Fox Ears headband

I looked closely at the last story that came out.

Why on earth is this story here?

'Owner of the Fox Ears Headband''

According to my thoughts, this 'story' was definitely that 'story'.

Probably when <Kim Dokja Company> visited the amusement park in <Oz>.

「"What are you doing here?"」

When I turned around, Yoo Joonghyuk was there, wearing a fox headband as expected.」

… Even if it's not that story, it doesn't matter. Anyway, since 'fox' was included, it was a story that could be used immediately.

'I will choose number 461.'

[The historical-grade story, 'Owner of the Fox Ears Headband' has been acquired.]

I immediately started talking.

Of course, if you use this 'story', a fox that wasn't there won't suddenly appear.

After all, what is included in this story is not a fox, but 'fox ears'.

[The story 'Owner of the Fox Ear Headband' begins its storytelling.]

I looked at my mask reflected in the window.

It is said that in this world, the 'mask' is a story that protects oneself.

But if this 'mask' is really a story.

'Stick.'

It would also be possible to tie together stories and stories.

'Stick.'

How many times has the story been told like that?

[The story 'Owner of the Fox Ears Headband' responds to your will.]

My mask began to emit a faint light. The prisoners watching us nearby let out exclamations.

"Oh, oh—!"

The shape of my previously invisible mask changed in real time. The mask's snout grew pointed, and small ears also sprouted from its head.

It literally looks like a 'fox mask'.

[The story 'The Fox and the Crane' is looking at you.]

The owner of the crane also held my hand with an expression of emotion.

"So, you… were you the fox?"

"No."

The fox in this story is dead.

Even if I were to act as the fox's replacement and successfully stage the story, the story would only be talked about for a moment.

"I can help you, but even if you recreate the 「stage」 like this, the effect will only be temporary."

"I know that."

As in 「The Three Little Pigs」, there may be ways to change the plot of the story and introduce new stories or make other animals appear, but these are also temporary measures.

"Don’t you want to become famous again?"

"What do you mean?"

"Originally, 'The Fox and the Crane' is a story as famous as 'The Three Little Pigs'.

The owner looked confused.

"Don’t you want to share your story with the <Star Stream> once again?"

Creating a story that everyone knows about in the <Star Stream>. It is the dream of every Constellation shining in the sky.

"As you know, the reason Zone 13's stories are weakening is because you're trapped in the Recycling Center."

"I know, but we can’t leave the center."

"You are like that. But what about 'stories'?"

The crane owner looked at me with an expression of disbelief.

I nodded and added.

"We are spreading the story inside the Recycling Center throughout the <Star Stream>."

"That’s impossible. The Constellations outside the center cannot know what happened inside the center. The stories that occur here cannot possibly become famous."

"In principle, yes."

And from here was the second stage of my operation.

'Bihyung'.

If you can't see it, just make it visible.

'Please open the channel.'

---

—You crazy person!

As expected, Bihyung appeared quickly.

—You crazy person! You crazy guy!

'Stop and listen to me.'

—Shut up, you crazy!

'…'

—Outside now, do you know what's going on? Are you out of your mind?

'What happened?'

—Are you asking because you really don’t know? Have you forgotten what you and your sponsor did right before entering the 'Recycling Center'?

I remembered what happened at the Washington Dome.

—The Constellations are now gathering outside the Recycling Center, you know?

'What Constellations?'

—Who could it be?

I can roughly guess.

<Asgard>, <Olympus>, <Ghost>, <Vedas>, <Tree of Protection>.

There must have been a lot of Constellations from the Nebulae that were targeting us from the Washington Dome.

There will also be other Constellations of the Nebulae that flock to us after hearing the rumor.

When I think about it, it's a little scary.

—Do you feel it now?

Considering the scale of what I and the 'Demon King of Salvation' had done, it was not strange.

The 'Demon King of Salvation' killed dozens of Historical-grade Constellations belonging to each giant Nebula in 'Gingagap' of the mythical stage <Asgard>.

Where is that?

He even defeated 'Ares', who was Narrative-grade and was listed as one of the 12 gods of <Olympus>.

Naturally, the Constellations of <Asgard> and <Olympus> would have been greatly strengthened. Other Nebulae may also be starting to become curious about us.

Some Nebulae must have confirmed that the contract between me and the 'Demon King of Salvation' has not been terminated.

—I'm sure you'll be trapped in the underground torture chamber of 'Tartaros', where you'll be treated horribly, your ego will be removed, and you'll be used as a doll weapon!

'That's very specific.'

—So you must never get caught. You're definitely hidden inside the 'Recycling Center'. Never go outside. Outside Constellations cannot enter here, so you'll be safe...

'Thank you for your concern.'

—Why would I be worried about you? I'm just afraid that the value of my product will be damaged! Do you remember that our contract was extended? Your sponsor…

'I know.'

—Who knows that? Let's open the channel?

'I'm not asking to open a live channel. We want to open a channel through which only stories can be distributed.'

—No, what are you talking about…

'If the product has value, you must sell it before its value falls.'

—What?

'I heard everyone is waiting for me?'

Even if I'm trapped inside the Recycling Center, there's something I can feel.

[The power of the story 'The One Who Rewrites Fate' becomes stronger.]

Even now, the story of the Demon King of Salvation and me is becoming famous.

However, at this exact moment, I, the incarnation of the 'Demon King of Salvation', ended up in the 'Recycling Center'.

As Bihyung said, this is a place where external Constellations cannot intervene or spy.

The Constellations' curiosity about me will continue to grow.

'Then I have to live up to their expectations.'

We cannot remain trapped in the 'Recycling Center' forever. The moment will surely come when I have to escape from here and face the Nebulae.

Until then, the vast gap between the Constellations and me must be bridged.

'Bihyung, you like coins, right?'

And in this <Star Stream>, there is a very efficient means to fill that gap.

[The story 'The Fox and the Crane' has stopped its storytelling.]

[The story 'The Magpie Who Returned the Favor' has stopped its storytelling.]

[The story 'The Goose that Laid the Golden Egg' has stopped its storytelling.]

…

I said, rewriting my mask.

'From now on, I plan to appear in all stories of Zone 13. So you—'

After all, trends come and go.

I grinned as I looked at the endless 'recycled stories'.

'Sell the stories I will appear in to the Constellations who pay coins.'

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 740 Episode 30 Zodiac (2)

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We immediately tried to 'reenact the story'. The first thing we did was divide into teams.

"I'll take charge of the stage."

It was Cha Yerin who took care of the stage.

"I gained new abilities."

Wearing a snail mask, she was recently able to handle the stories embedded in the 'mask'.

Cha Yerin muttered softly as she placed one of her hands on the floor, and a moment later a snail's nest grew from the floor.

[The story 'Snail House' begins its storytelling.]

It was no ordinary snail house. It was a space large enough for two adult men to stay there without any problems.

What's more interesting is that inside of this house is not actually a 'snail house'.

If it's a bathroom, it's a bathroom. A living room is a living room. A kitchen is a kitchen.

The ability of her story 'Snail House' was to be able to recreate its interior in whatever form she wanted.

Cha Yerin said, avoiding our gazes as if she was embarrassed, "I'm not yet familiar with stories, so it only lasts a day. It also takes about 30 minutes to make."

A house where you can decorate the interior the way you want. As long as I had this, there was no problem no matter where I stayed.

Kyung Sein said with admiration,

"If you had acquired this ability a little sooner, we could have cleared 「The Three Little Pigs」 with it."

"It would have been difficult because it doesn't look like a brick house from the outside."

"Ugh, I can't lose, Dokja-ssi. I'll bring the stage props. Can I get a gourd and a plate?"

Before I could answer, Kyung Sein, who activated [Way of the Wind], flew into the sky.

Cha Yerin said,

"She has become a real flying squirrel."

Perhaps because it was combined with the story of the flying squirrel mask, Kyung Sein was able to use [Way of the Wind] faster than anyone else in the group.

Dansu ahjussi, who was watching next to her, also added a word.

"Then I…"

"You can stay still."

The man's face turned sour, so I quickly added.

"There are quite a few stories of turtles appearing. You will have a chance to become active soon."

"Then, I will practice [Way of the Wind]. Since I am a turtle, I should at least practice it consistently…"

"Good. If you gain any new insight, please let me know."

Meanwhile, Cha Yerin, who had completed preparing the stage, reported.

"The stage is ready."

The key event in this recreated story, 'The Fox and the Crane', was that the fox and the crane invited each other to their homes and served soup.

"Oh wow, it really is just like my old kitchen."

The crane expressed his admiration for the kitchen created by Cha Yerin.

Perhaps lost in a brief memory, the crane looked carefully at the two kitchens.

"This side too… yes. That fox friend’s kitchen was just like this."

[‘Staging’ activation conditions have been met.]

I nodded.

"If you’re ready, let’s get started right away."

['Staging' is activated!]

[The story 'The Fox and the Crane' begins!]

[Your 'mask' corresponds to the fable.]

With the system message, my body temporarily changed to resemble that of a fox.

It seemed like it was probably a phenomenon that occurred due to 'staging'.

I took a deep breath and spoke.

"I’ll treat you today."

「The grumpy fox said to the crane.」

The voice of a story flowing out.

The crane owner looked at the sentence for a moment with eyes filled with longing, and then nodded his head willingly.

"Good, let’s go to your house."

「The crane answered with a smile.」

We entered the fox's kitchen together. As everyone knows, the events that would occur in the future were predetermined.

The fox deliberately offers soup on a flat plate to the crane. The long-beaked crane cannot eat the soup on the plate, and the grumpy fox licks the soup clean from the plate as if teasing the crane.

It's a very mischievous and simple story.

"Now, please eat."

The crane saw the plate I served and smiled.

"The soup looks delicious."

"It’s a very delicious soup."

"I remember the first time you served me this soup."

"It was already a long time ago."

The crane looked into the soup and he asked.

"Do you still think people will like this soup?"

That's a line that didn't exist originally.

I had no idea that the crane would make such an ad-lib, so I thought for a moment before answering.

"Not all soups can be loved equally."

"I guess so. I know."

The crane had somewhat sad eyes.

I watched the crane and opened my mouth again.

"But."

「The grumpy fox looked down at the soup for a moment and then added.」

"Someone will miss this soup. It must mean something."

The crane that heard those words was silent for a moment.

How much time has passed like that?

The crane's tears fell on the plate.

"As expected, I can’t eat your soup this time."

With no one speaking, only the story continued to talk.

「The fox ate the delicious soup, and the crane looked down at the plate of soup he couldn’t eat.」

It was truly a perfect recreation of the first half.

If only the next sentence hadn't been added.

「And outside the kitchen window, a panda was chewing bamboo.」

---

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 9% of prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

After the first half of the 「staging」 was over, Cha Yerin was the first to open her mouth.

"Is the panda a MacGuffin?"

In another corner, there was Ye Hyunwoo, who repeatedly bowed his head to his companions.

"I’m sorry… I suddenly wanted to eat bamboo."

"No, why are you suddenly eating bamboo there?"

In response to Kyung Sein's scolding, Ye Hyunwoo lowered his head as if he had no shame.

"These days, strangely enough, I keep wanting to chew bamboo in prominent places…"

Dansu ahjussi asked me with a worried expression.

"Can you film the first half again?"

"This is not a movie."

There is no concept of reshoots in the story. Once activated, 「Staging」 is recorded as is.

In other words, all stories are like one-take movies.

"Why a panda! There's a panda there!"

Meanwhile, the owner of the original story was also turning insane.

I answered while ignoring the original owner's screams.

"For now, we don't have time, so let's start the second half."

The staging resumed immediately.

This stage is the crane's house.

「Meanwhile, the crane that was tricked by the fox decided to take revenge.」

The crane owner confidently placed a gourd on the table.

"Please enjoy, I will treat you today."

"It will taste good."

As expected from the owner of the story who has recreated the story countless times, the crane skillfully stuck its beak down and began to suck the soup from the gourd.

Of course I couldn't eat the soup. This is because the spout of the gourd containing the soup was too thin for me to eat.

「Then the crane smiled and asked.」

"Why aren't you eating? Are you wondering if you've been poisoned?"

I smiled bitterly.

"The soup in the gourd looks so delicious that I can't eat it."

"Is that so?"

We looked at each other and laughed.

This was the ending of 「The Fox and the Crane」, which everyone knows.

The story of the fox is that he gets back the karma of his mischief and decides to treat others well from now on.

I don't know if this kind of story is still popular these days, but it was sure to be popular with Constellations who like good stories.

If it weren't for the next sentence.

「But the fox foresaw this situation and called his friend.」

When I suddenly raised my head, the crane owner was also looking at me.

"Friend?"

I don’t remember doing something like that?

Before I could respond in embarrassment, the crane’s kitchen door opened.

「The fox’s friend, the wolf, was there.」

"I never understood it since I was young," said the wolf.

「The wolf came straight towards the fox and the crane.」

"Why can’t you eat this?"

「The wolf muttered as if he didn’t understand and snatched the gourd from the fox’s hand.」

"Isn’t it okay to drink it like this?"

「The wolf put the bottle in his mouth and gulped down the soup.」

I looked up at the wolf blankly. The surprised crane was also the same.

「After a while, the wolf who had eaten all the soup in the vial spoke.」

"It’s delicious."

「While everyone was silent, a panda was chewing bamboo outside the kitchen window.」

---

"Cut! COOOOOOOO!"

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 8% of prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

"Kooooooooo!"

The crane's feathers fluttered. If the prisoners nearby had not stopped him, I would have been killed at any moment.

"You guys! You guys ruined my story!"

[The 'stage' is polluted!]

[The plot of the story is distorted!]

"Just calm down for a moment."

"Do I really look like myself now!"

I spoke to reassure the crane, who was almost out of breath.

"Don’t worry, it’s all intentional."

"Intentional? Did you just say intentional?"

"Aren’t you here to ask us to change the story? That’s why we changed it to the way that’s popular these days."

It was a lie.

"I swear on my name."

This story is ruined.

Perhaps now the story 'The Fox and the Crane' will be changed to 'The Fox, the Crane and the Wolf—often a Panda'.

The name of the story became strange, and the moral or standard of the story collapsed.

But I think this way.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' likes the idea of wolves.]

Just because it's a bad story doesn't mean it's not popular.

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' says he has learned a new lesson.]

In fact, some stories sell well just because they fail.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' says the panda is so cute.]

"The evaluators say it’s okay."

The crane looked puzzled at my words.

"Are they…?"

"These are people who have been summoned to serve as story evaluators."

I didn't start this bold plan without any safety measures in place.

If you are supplying stories, there must be standards for the stories to be delivered.

For reference, there are a total of three Constellations that I have invited through Bihyung.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' tells you to bring a hot story next time.]

The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon'.

This guy, who only likes 'cider'-centered stories, was perfect to represent the impatient Constellations.

Of course, not everyone likes cider like the Black Flame Dragon.

There are certainly Constellations in the <Star Stream> that like elegant and cultured stories.

For example,

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' feels profound insight in the transformation of the story.]

In the cultured faction, the 'Reclining Dragon'.

This smart Constellation was perfect for representing Constellations with intellectual vanity.

However, in the case of this type, there were cases where they insisted that messy stories were good, perhaps because of their compulsion to somehow find meaning in the stories.

The third Constellation was recruited to prevent it.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' likes the friendship between the fox and the crane.]

Sensitivity, 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs'.

I invited this Constellation on the recommendation of Bihyung, but I have not yet found out their identity.

Even though sheep is included in their modifier, they don’t seem to belong to the <Zodiac>.

However, looking at the standards for evaluating the story, I felt that it was somewhat emotional, so it could make up for the shortcomings of the other two Constellations.

"If we can satisfy all three, we will be able to capture 80% of the <Star Stream>."

"Really?"

I nodded and looked at the sky.

'Bihyung, are you ready?'

Then Bihyung responded as if he had been waiting.

—Are you really confident?

'I heard the Constellations are waiting for news from me outside right now?'

—Yes, but.

'Then, even if you come up with a story like 「Dung pretending to be soybean paste」, they will still eat it. Which channel will you distribute the stories through?'

—I decided to stop by the Gourmet Association. The center director said it was okay if it was distributed through there.

Right. It's called 'Gourmet Association'.

'That's good because there are a lot of Constellations with weird tastes there.'

—Did you have any friendships with the Gourmet Association Constellations?

'I just heard something somewhere.'

[The story you were involved in was submitted through the Management Bureau.]

[The name of the story has been changed due to malformed staging.]

[The story 'The Fox, the Crane, and the Wolf—often Panda' is transmitted.]

The strange story we created pierced the ceiling of the center and disappeared, leaving behind a long tail.

As I watched the tail of the story drifting away, I felt a sense of nostalgia.

I felt this way when I started my first series.

After a long time, I turned on my smartphone and checked 「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」 posted on the platform.

The side story was still being serialized in real time on the platform.

I clicked on the most recent episode and checked the comments.

[One free daily pass will be deducted.]

[Regardless of the order, one comment from that episode will be revealed at random.]

| |
|---|
| —Poo■Oh? |

I looked at the comments for a while and then tilted my head. ■What is that?

'Oro Castle' in the dark dimension.

In this place, the territory of 'Immeasurable Strictness', one of the 72 Demon Kings, there were informal gatherings held periodically.

In the <Star Stream>, a group of Constellations who love stories more than anyone else, and who loved stories so much that they slightly turned away.

The Gourmet Association.

Like the hipsters of the <Star Stream>, it was their routine to criticize each other's tastes in stories from different generations.

But today, a different gastronomic wind was blowing at the Gourmet Association.

"Hey, have you tried that?"

"Oh, of course."

Normally, they would have been retelling sword master stories, but today they were telling strange stories.

The Demon King 'Worthless Darkness' said with admiration.

"My God, isn’t this a fable? A First-Generation story."

"It’s based on the first generation, but it’s properly arranged."

He added, as if he found the idea of 'a person who overcomes trials one step too late' interesting.

"If you look at the title, it sounds a bit like 'The High Plain of Heaven'. Old Drinking Man, do you know anything?"

"Kyung! We didn’t make it. I thought the stories about animals would be really boring."

As the 'Old Drinking Man' spoke in a grumpy voice, the 'Brash Swamp Predator' added:

"The part this fox says is pretty delicious."

"What is this panda?"

"I think that’s the point. It’s unique."

Next, the 'Lord of Forgotten Envy' and the 'Owner of the White Castle' added their words.

"Interesting."

Even the Constellations that would normally be at odds with each other agreed.

A rare peace that came to the Gourmet Association.

The Constellations were immersed in their own thoughts for a long time in the brief peace.

It was at that time that some thugs had burst through the main gate of Oro Castle.

"What are you all eating?"

A young monkey that has grown into a golden beauty. Some of the Constellations that discovered the monkey muttered in contemplation.

"Damn it, the monkey bastard is here."

While the Constellations were slowly leaving their seats, there was the only Constellation that greeted him.

He was 'One Who Overcame the Trials One Step Too Late'

"Oh, King Mifu. Are you here?"

Then the 'King of Stone Monkeys' also nodded slightly and asked.

"I can't see Jeongjunjwa today?"

"That guy doesn’t show up often these days. Instead, you should try this."

"What is it?"

"It’s a popular story these days. It’s a story from the animal world. Have you never heard of it?"

The 'King of the Stone Monkeys' looked down at the story presented by the 'One Who Overcame the Trials One Step Too Late' and frowned.

"It doesn’t look tasty. It’s a story about kids who didn’t make it into the Chinese Zodiac."

"Try it and tell me. It’s a story that we worked hard to obtain."

The Monkey King tilted his head and reluctantly picked up a piece of story.

And after a while, hair sprouted from the Monkey King's arms.

"This... where does this story come from?"

"From the Recycling Center."

"Who made it?"

The speed at which King Mifu extended his hand toward the story became faster and faster. The 'One Who Overcame Trials One Step Too Late' smiled and replied to King Mifu.

"It’s a guy named Kim Dokja."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 741 Episode 30 Zodiac (3)

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I will start with the conclusion.

[Your approval rating increases.]

[Currently, 16% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

Our story was a success.

[Your approval rating increases.]

[Currently, 25% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

To be more precise.

[Your approval rating increases.]

[Currently, 32% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

Our stories have become quite popular.

The system message I heard from earlier was proof of that.

[The influence of the story 'The Fox, the Crane and the Wolf—often the Panda' is strong.]

The name may be a bit strange, but it somehow became famous. And as I keep watching, I feel like this is more sensational than 'The Fox and the Crane'.

It's like how the name Yoo Joonghyuk feels more beautiful in terms of naming than Kim Dokja.

"I-I am becoming famous. My story is becoming famous again."

The crane, who checked the message in real time, was glaring at the system window as if his eyes were tearing.

Is it because the story has regained its power? I could feel the magic power overflowing from his whole body.

The other beastmen's expressions also changed when they saw the change in the crane.

"Can you make stories like the crane's?"

A prisoner, who had been hesitating all along, asked.

"My stories too! I want my stories too!"

All the prisoners who were seeing an opportunity also grabbed me and started shouting.

"You should make an appearance yourself!"

"Please let the panda appear too!"

"It’s okay even if the story turns into a mess. I want to be remembered once again. Oh my __"

Those who have lost their dreams recognize the void in their dreams more clearly than anyone else.

"I want to let the Star Stream know that I also existed."

"All right."

As I watched the prisoners' expressions change, I felt an inexplicable sadness.

What drove them like this? Why do they want to become famous and spread their stories?

[The story 'The Swallow Carrying Gourd Seeds' wants to tell its story again.]

Is it their will or the will of the story?

[The story 'The Dove and the Jackdaw' wants to talk again.]

I don't know. It's not a problem I can discuss.

However, I am a writer who writes stories.

[The story 'The Goose that Laid Golden Eggs' wants to tell its story again.]

If there is a story that wants me, I will just live up to its expectations.

"Now, please come here one by one and line up."

The <Zodiac> was not the <Zodiac> from the beginning.

So, do you know?

Who among the beastmen here will become the new <Zodiac> and be on our side?

It doesn't matter if that's not the case.

[Your approval rating increases.]

[Currently, 33% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

Even at this moment, the approval rating is steadily rising.

---

Two more days passed like that.

[Your approval rating increases.]

[Currently, 70% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

Over the course of two days, we transformed numerous stories into stages.

For example,「The swallow carrying gourd seeds」.

The swallow said that the stage production could not be created because there were no humans during that time.

"As expected, it is possible to escape without notice. I thought it would never be possible to recreate it in Zone 13."

[The name of the story has been changed due to malformed staging.]

[The story 'The Panda Who Saw the Swallow Carrying Park Seeds' was born.]

Stories related to pigeons, jackdaws, elephants, parrots, and hyenas were also performed.

The way we changed it was up to us. Sometimes a wolf appeared, sometimes a panda appeared, and I, who was able to transform using the mask, performed the role they were lacking depending on the time.

"Thank you, thank you so much!"

Of course, not all story transformations were smooth. It was especially dangerous during 「The Goose That Laid the Golden Egg」. A goose that had not laid eggs for too long fainted while laying eggs.

"This guy won't wake up. If the staging ends like this—"

"He's dead."

"Yes?"

A catastrophe occurred on stage in which the actual owner of the story died. In fact, the 「Goose That Laid the Golden Egg」 is destined to die from having its stomach ripped open, but isn't it still a premature death?

When opinions arose about whether this story should be abandoned, I called Dansu ahjussi.

"Ahjussi."

"Yes."

"Don't turtles lay eggs too?"

Dansu ahjussi looked back at me with an expression of bewilderment.

"I am not a goose. I am not a goose."

"I'm not asking you to give birth to them either. But wouldn't it be possible for you to incubate the egg?"

Dansu ahjussi was urgently deployed as an assistant incubating geese.

Dansu ahjussi had a strange expression on his face as he held the lukewarm egg.

"It looks like something is wriggling."

He worked hard to hatch the golden egg, and when a goose was finally born from the egg, everyone was so moved that they clapped their hands.

With this, the story of the goose continued.

Dansu ahjussi shed tears as if he were seeing his own child.

"I understand Han Myungoh now."

[The name of the story has been changed due to malformed staging.]

[The story 'The Turtle With the Golden Goose Egg and The Panda Who Happened to be There' was born.]

"Evaluators!"

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' says it was fun because he stupidly didn’t cut open the goose’s belly.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' deplores the fate of the goose meta-sacrificing itself to the golden universalism, and is moved by the tragedy of the story that will once again lead to the birth of a new life...]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' says that the turtle’s fatherly love brings tears to his eyes.]

"Verification complete! Send!"

We repeated sending the story as soon as it was completed.

The temporal density of the 'Recycling Center' is much longer than outside, so new stories will continue to be supplied in real time outside.

According to Bihyung's fuss, so many Constellations were paying coins to read our stories that it would be incomprehensible to anyone outside the center.

—This is an indirect message sent by the Constellations outside. Read it when you have time.

Messages from the Constellations?

I looked at the list of compressed messages I received from Bihyung.

[The Constellation 'Lily Blooming in Aquarius' says the panda is really cute.]

[The Constellation 'Friend of Justice and Harmony' says that cute things are always right.]

[The Constellation 'Goddess of the Morning Star' asks when the Panda will appear again.]

…

The ones that responded were mainly the Constellations of the absolute good faction.

I looked to see if there was a message from Uriel, but Uriel was nowhere to be seen.

I felt strangely sad.

For some reason, the fact that Uriel wasn't there felt like proof that I wasn't a proper Kim Dokja yet.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is starving.]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is glaring at you.]

[Currently, you have 3 days left to live.]

3 days.

Now is the time to replenish.

Now that I think about it, the time has come for it to come in.

—By the way, the compensation that was delayed has also arrived.

Also.

[The reward for the sub-scenario 'The Fox and the Crane' has been obtained!]

[12,000 coins obtained!]

['Unidentified story fragment' has been acquired!]

The reward for the sub-scenario we cleared earlier—'The Fox and the Crane' has now arrived.

There was a reason for the delay in compensation.

—It was a bit late to explain things to the higher-ups. This is my first time clearing a scenario like this.

I had an idea what the situation would be.

Although the story was reproduced, the name of the story was changed in the process, so the Management Bureau would have been at a loss as to whether to view this as a reproduction of 'The Fox and the Crane'.

—Anyway, I got scolded for insisting that it was to protect the Story when the fox and the crane showed up.

'Thank you.'

—No. Rather, the story is going really well, so keep it going.

It seemed like Bihyung's eyes were slowly starting to turn when he saw the coins coming in.

—Did you see the Constellations' messages? There are many Constellations requesting that the Panda to continue to appear. I don't really understand, but the panda you featured is really hot these days.

'Pandas are cute.'

—Anyway, I don't know the tastes of the Constellations. Why do they like that?

I smiled bitterly.

This is why the Constellations like pandas.

'It's probably because they're so lonely.'

—Lonely?

Kyrgios once said the following about 'scenarios'.

「It would be because this universe would be so lonely without them.」

Even Constellations do not necessarily know why they like certain stories.

However, at some point in their lives, they encounter a certain story as if by fate, and seeing that story, they burn themselves and shine.

The story shines brighter under the light of the stars, and it eventually becomes the story that attracts attention in the <Star Stream>.

'If everyone is watching the same story, it'll be less lonely.'

—What is this nonsense?

Instead of answering Bihyung's words, I tried using the 'unidentified story fragment'.

['Unidentified story fragment' reveals its identity.]

[The story fragment 'Kim Dokja's Third Way' has been acquired.]

The reward received was, as expected, 'Fragments of Kim Dokja'.

When I first entered the 'Recycling Center', I acquired Kim Dokja's 'story fragment' as a scenario reward.

As expected, the 'Recycling Center Director' seemed to be giving out stories like this on purpose as a reward.

Why? For what purpose?

I don't know right now, but it was a very fortunate thing for me now.

Without hesitation, I ordered the story to feast.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' feasts on the story fragment 'Kim Dokja's Third Way'!]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name''s hunger is appeased.]

A warm feeling spread deep within my heart, and a message immediately came to mind.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor has increased.]

[You can use the story fragment 'Kim Dokja’s Third Method'.]

'Kim Dokja’s Third Method'.

What ability does this fragment have?

[8-day time limit has been added.]

It was then that someone grabbed my shoulder.

"Dokja-ssi."

When I turned around, Ye Hyunwoo was there.

Ye Hyunwoo asked as if he had read my expression.

"Are you okay?"

"Oh, yes. I’m sorry."

The reason I was surprised was simple.

This is because I could not notice Ye Hyunwoo’s presence at all.

I used predation after confirming that there were no people around, but when did he approach me?

No matter how much he mastered [Way of the Wind], he was not skilled enough to completely hide his presence.

"I was thinking for a moment. What’s going on?"

I remembered what happened when I absorbed Kim Kyungsik's soul.

I couldn't forget Goo Seonah's shocked face when she saw me eating the 'Kim Dokja fragment'. After that, I never met Goo Seonah.

Ye Hyunwoo asked me with the same expression as Goo Seonah back then.

"Would it be okay?"

"Yes?"

"Stories. I was wondering if it would be okay for us to mend the stories as we please."

Ah, was that the story?

I answered with some relief.

"It’s okay. They are historical stories anyway."

[The influence of the story you are involved with, 'The Panda Who Saw the Swallow Carrying Park Seeds', becomes stronger.]

[The influence of the story you were involved with, 'The Turtle With The Golden Egg and The Panda Who Happened to be There', becomes stronger.]

[The name of 'Kim Dokja' begins to become known throughout the <Star Stream>.]

Originally, it would have been impossible to repair the stories in this way.

However, this was only possible because this was the 'Recycling Center', permission was obtained from the owners of the stories, and the grade of the story itself was low.

"As you know, if the story level increases, you can’t fix it this way."

It is not easy to intervene on stage in a legendary story.

If the repair had been easy, Kim Dokja would have gotten a lot of stories like 「The Secretive Plotter and Kim Dokja」 or 「The Dokkaebi King and Kim Dokja」.

[Attribute proficiency increases.]

Anyway, this 'Operation Repair' was quite enjoyable for me.

I earned coins, acquired story shares, and built up proficiency related to characteristics.

I think my skill level related to 'writer' has probably increased. I can't check it because the Attribute Window is still not open.

"I knew that there were 'story repairers' in the demon world, but this was the first time I knew that we could fix stories like this."

"Because it’s a method that doesn’t appear in the main story."

"How did you know, Dokja-ssi?"

"I read Ways of Survival."

Ye Hyunwoo chuckled, probably thinking it was a joke.

"At times like this, you really seem like Dokja-ssi."

"It’s a compliment, right?"

"Dokja-ssi."

"Yes."

"Dokja-ssi."

"Yes."

"Are you really Dokja-ssi?"

Come to think of it, Ye Hyunwoo had asked the same question before.

"In a way."

At my answer, which was different from before, Ye Hyunwoo was silent for a moment.

Night was falling again in Zone 13.

Ye Hyunwoo asked as he looked at the smoke rising from the chimney of the house across from the vacant lot.

"Do you have a family?"

"I have my parents."

For the first time in a while, I remembered my parents' faces. Parents who remind me of a gentle spring night.

"I’m jealous. I don’t have one."

I stood there in silence for a moment, not knowing what to say.

In times like this, should I comfort him or ask him something more?

Now that I think about it, I still didn't know anything about Ye Hyunwoo.

He is the 7th Apostle of the Apostle Society, and a friend of Noh Jiyoon, the daughter of Dansu ahjussi.

That was all I knew about 'Ye Hyunwoo'.

What is his real name? Is he a man or a woman, where does he live, and what are his favorite hobbies?

I have no idea.

"Even when I go back to reality, there’s no one waiting for me."

I recalled that Ye Hyunwoo was listed as a 'character'. At that time, I asked what our goal was, and Ye Hyunwoo answered like this.

「"Being happy?"」

The air in the area felt subtly distorted.

"Hyunwoo, it’s not like that. It’s definitely true in real life too—"

"Was Kim Dokja happy in real life?"

I closed my mouth.

Ye Hyunwoo continued to ask.

"Could it be that Kim Dokja also ran away to this world because reality was painful?"

I couldn't answer. It was a question that should not be answered now.

"If someone should become 'Kim Dokja'."

Ye Hyunwoo’s voice from behind changed.

"Wouldn’t it be more reasonable for someone who has nothing more to lose to become 'Kim Dokja'?"

In that moment I turned my head due to an eerie feeling and realized something sharp passed by my cheek.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 742 Episode 30 Zodiac (4)

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Spots of blood and thin cuts.

A few hairs fluttered and fell to the floor due to Ye Hyunwoo's wind.

I looked down at the hair and said.

"If it is reasonable for someone who has nothing more to lose to become 'Kim Dokja', then it is not right for Hyunwoo to become Kim Dokja as well."

"I know."

To conclude, Ye Hyunwoo's attack was not directed at me.

Ye Hyunwoo's wind passed by me and collided with something in the air on the other side.

The sound of something falling on the floor. Sounds reminiscent of the claws of large animals were scattered about.

When [Way of the Wind] was activated from Ye Hyunwoo's fingertips, the face of the assassin hiding in the alley was revealed.

"Tsk-"

The assassin had the face of a bear. The so-called Bear Beastman.

It was an animal that had never been seen here before.

The guy must have sensed danger and immediately growled and ran out of the alley.

But Ye Hyunwoo was faster.

Ye Hyunwoo, who flew with [Way of the Wind], was already standing behind the beast.

“Quad deuk.”

The bear's knees bent to opposite sides, making an eerie sound.

As the bear howled in pain, Ye Hyunwoo grabbed the back of its neck and asked.

"What are you doing, you?"

A completely different tone from usual. Gurgling, blood bubbles flowed from the mouth of the frightened bear beast.

"Who ordered you here? Tell me. If you don’t speak until the count of three, you will die."

A menacing tone of voice that he never showed in front of me. I once again realize what kind of person he is.

He is the 7th aApostle of the Apostolic Association and the actual representative of Chungmuro.

"One."

While coming this far, Ye Hyunwoo must have been caught up in countless plots and schemes that I was unaware of.

The bear beast panted and spoke as if in a fit.

"You will never succeed."

The prisoner was left lying limp on the floor. It looks like the stories and magic power he had were not enough.

It was almost surprising that a surprise attack was attempted in this condition.

Ye Hyunwoo frowned.

"Shall we wake him up again and torture him the Kim Dokja way?"

It was then that I heard a system message in my ears.

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 68% of prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

It was strange.

Since the start of full-scale narrative repair, the approval rating has not fallen even once.

But why is the approval rating dropping at this time?

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 67% of prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

Ye Hyunwoo also looked at me, probably feeling uncomfortable.

"Something doesn’t feel right. I guess my companions…"

I saw a group of shadows approaching through a dark alley.

Lanterns rising one by one from the darkness.

It wasn't like they came to ask for a change in the story. This was because the faces of the prisoners swaying like ghosts above the lanterns were unfamiliar.

Not only the face but also the size was the same. Their physiques are at least twice as large as those of the beasts in the nearby area.

[It was true that the southern wolves were exterminated.]

A mantra that sends shivers down your spine.

There was a brown bear there, a meter taller than the other beasts, wearing a skull mask that covered half of its face.

[The Constellation 'A bear that will Spare One's life if One pretends to be Dead'’s eyes are flashing.]

Judging by the pressure felt and the atmosphere it gave off, there was no doubt about it.

That guy is a 'Historical-grade Constellation'.

[The story that makes up this incarnation has been greatly worn.]

To be precise, it is the incarnation of a Historical-grade Constellation that has lost most of its stories and whose status has been greatly reduced.

An animal-type Constellation that failed to enter the <Zodiac> and remained in Zone 13.

It seemed to be a similar case to 'The Wolf Who Covets Little Red Riding Hood', which we fought against before.

In the darkness, the brown bear's huge claws gave off a cold light.

[Kill them all. The southern part of Zone 13 is the 'Bear' area from today.]

After repeating his words in unison, the bear beasts began plundering, crushing all the surrounding houses with their huge paws.

"W-what! Kwaaaaaaaa!"

Claws flew in without asking or answering. The prisoners, their entire houses torn apart, were screaming.

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 66% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

I understand why the approval rating continues to decrease. Those bears were randomly slaughtering the prisoners in Zone 13 who supported us.

Looking at the numbers, the number of troops seems to be well over 300.

Ye Hyunwoo opened his mouth.

"That guy is the same case as the 'wolf' back then, right?"

"Yes. I think we need to be careful. This time, there is no story to use."

With the wolves, the「Three Little Pig」scenario was in effect, so staging could be used.

This time the case is different.

But Ye Hyunwoo had calm eyes.

"Here, would I be like Kim Dokja by taking the lead and fighting, or would I be more like Kim Dokja if I had to hide behind and encourage my companions?"

I thought for a moment and then answered.

"They both feel like Kim Dokja."

Kim Dokja would have been at the forefront of the fight while encouraging his companions to fight behind the scenes.

Ye Hyunwoo nodded his head as if he understood what I said.

"Then I'll do as I please here."

Black magic power flowed from Ye Hyunwoo's whole body. I was a little surprised because it was my first time seeing him truly start a story.

[The story 'Armless Panda' growls.]

Originally, Ye Hyunwoo was a supporter-type incarnation who mainly used [Magic Charge] and [Magic Sharing] skills.

A skill position with a combination in mind with Gong Pildu, who uses [Magic Turret] from the beginning.

However, here, Ye Hyunwoo gained the power to change his position.

"Kaaaaak!"

Every time Ye Hyunwoo's sword moved, there was a cracking sound of something breaking. It was the same fist that had grazed my mask earlier.

The bears who saw Ye Hyunwoo screamed.

"Bear?"

"Stop! We are the same kind!"

"I'm not a bear."

Ye Hyunwoo said without a smile, holding a bamboo stick near his mouth.

"I'm a panda."

Most of the beastmen in Zone 13 are incarnations whose stories have been damaged.

However, there were also people who had made a name for themselves before joining the 'Recycling Center'. Those prisoners were unable to stop Ye Hyunwoo and fell out one after another.

Now Ye Hyeonwoo has combat power comparable to that of the highest-level incarnations, even with his support-related skills sealed.

"Oh my god, is this guy really him?"

"The 'panda' is here!"

"Kill the damn story thief!"

A story thief?

As the angry bears all rushed towards Ye Hyunwoo, Ye Hyunwoo's hands and feet also was ready to get busy.

Just then, my colleagues sensed the commotion and ran out from inside the brick house.

"What are those bears?"

"No, those bastards— Hyunwoo-ssi!"

Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, and Cha Yerin, who must have been sleeping, also rubbed her eyes and stuck her face out the window.

Afterwards, the crane owner came out screaming. The crane owner, who quickly looked around, seemed to have realized what was going on.

"Brown bear! What on earth are you doing? Why are you doing this—"

The brown bear paid no heed to the crane's words and continued to trample on the southern house site.

Kyung Sein asked with a frown.

"What are those bears?"

"These are the bears that rule the northern part of Zone 13. They never crossed over when there were wolves…"

The crane owner, his beak clenched, answered.

"I don’t know either. Why are they suddenly doing something like this… I heard that the northern beastmen are also showing favor towards them recently."

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 65% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

In the end, the crane owner also made a decision.

"All southern beasts, take up arms! Defend your home from the northerners!"

"Those who are injured, hide inside the brick house!"

The situation was not good. If this is the case, it will ultimately lead to conflict between the north and south.

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 64% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

The fight must be stopped.

If we cannot stop it, we must at least protect the prisoners in the southern region.

"If you can’t fight, just pretend to be dead! Then you have a chance of survival!"

The modifier of the brown bear that leads the bears is 'a bear that will Spare One's Lifeif One pretends to be dead'.

Judging by the story, if you're lucky, there's a chance that 'pretending to be dead' might work.

But that too is nothing more than a makeshift.

[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 63% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

How do we stop fighting?

Let's think. There is a reason for every incident in the <Star Stream>. There may be a reason why the bears came to the south now.

At that time, a shout from a corner caught my ear.

"Kill the panda!"

"Why does it appear in all the stories!"

"What’s so fun about chewing bamboo all the time!"

"I can roll around too!"

No way.

"Caught you!"

A bear whose nose was hit by Ye Hyunwoo passed out.

The number of bear beasts that Ye Hyunwoo had defeated had already exceeded ten, but the bears were still desperately clinging only to Ye Hyunwoo.

The reason was obvious.

"These bears want to become 'pandas'."

I shouted with all my magic.

"Everyone, stop!"

One by one, the bears surrounding Ye Hyunwoo turned to look at me.

"I will help your stories become famous again."

The bear beastmen's eyes were shaking when they heard what I said. It works.

"There’s no need to fight like this. If you’re jealous of the panda, you too can—"

[Shut up!]

With the brown bear's mantra, the bears stopped. The bears looked at each other and bared their teeth at us again.

[Kill him! Don’t let anyone who pretends to be dead live!]

I didn't understand. I told them this much, but they're still attacking me?

I activated 「Persistent Murim Master」 and cut down the two charging bears.

As I watched the bears' claws that had been clawing at me break apart, I realized how serious their condition was.

Each and every one of the seemingly fearsome bear beastmen was in need of immediate reinforcement.

These are people whose balance in their incarnation body has been completely destroyed due to the accumulation of life in the impoverished Zone 13.

They were attacking, ignoring their own lives.

[The story of the lost name is falling apart.]

Tales that are so old that it is unclear whether they can be staged.

Stories whose names have even disappeared and even the <Star Stream> has forgotten them.

A conversation with Lycaon from a few days ago flashed through my mind.

【I understand what student wants to do. But not everyone can be saved by student.】

At the time, I didn't know what that meant.

【Can we force our dreams on those who have lost their own stories forever, student?】

There are people in the world who have lost 'their own story' forever.

"Kill the panda! If you kill it, you will get the story!"

"It’s mine. It’s mine!"

"Aim for him! He has more stories than the panda!"

"There’s a wolf over there too!"

In a world where their own stories disappeared, what they could do was limited.

"Aim for the brick house! Most of the new stories are held by the beastmen over there!"

Stealing other people's dreams.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 743 Episode 30 Zodiac (5)

Killer King, who killed a charging bear, took a deep breath and said.

"This reminds me of the Demon World. Something similar happened there too."

I smiled bitterly.

Certainly, something similar happened in the demon world in the main story. The crowd, incited by the duke's henchmen, harassed Kim Dokja like they are doing now.

"You sound like you were there at the scene."

"If you read a story a hundred times, it becomes no different from what you actually experienced."

"Then you must know that something is strange about the current situation."

I saw bears looting houses. Even though we killed quite a few bears, there were still a lot of them. In fact, the number seemed to have increased even more than before.

"There is no way the bears would attack at this time."

"Why do you think so? It’s enough for those who are hungry for stories—"

"No matter how greedy you are, it won’t be more precious than your life. The rumor that we have an 'Outer God' would have spread throughout Zone 13."

Of course, according to the contract with me, Lycaon cannot intervene in the battle in any way. However, the <Zodiac>, including the beastmen of Zone 13, do not know that fact.

There was no way the northern bears would have hastily invaded this place, knowing of Lycaon's existence.

"That means—"

"Plundering the stories is only in name. Their real goal is probably to cause as many casualties as possible in Zone 13."

Among the casualties, there must have been prisoners who supported us or had feelings for us. When they die, our approval ratings naturally drop.

Killer King's eyes narrowed.

"Did these guys receive orders from the Chinese Zodiac?"

"Maybe so."

The <Zodiac>, which wanted to avoid direct conflict with us, has moved the bears in the north and is killing the beastmen in Zone 13 who support us.

It was reasonable to think so.

"Then can I kill that leader?"

I saw a brown bear displaying its mighty strength from afar—'a bear that will come back to life if One pretends to be dead.'

"I’m not sure. If he wasn’t the one who planned this invasion, killing him won’t end the fight."

I narrowed my eyes and stared into space.

Bear Beastmen are beings who are swayed by other people's stories because they do not have 'their own stories'. If so, there must also be a story that led them here.

If only we could find the source of the story—

"It takes time."

"How much."

"Five minutes is enough."

"No problem."

Killer King answered confidently, but everyone knew that he could never be sure.

It’s different from when he faced the wolves in「The Three Little Pigs」.

Although the brown bear was a discarded Constellation, it still had some of the power of a Constellation, and its subordinate Bear Beastmen numbered in the hundreds.

On the other hand, our beastmen are only herbivores with weak fighting power.

"Kaaaaak!"

The fleeing southern prisoners hurriedly hid in the 'Brick House', but the brick house did not function properly as it did in 'The Three Little Pigs'.

"Are the wolves really not able to destroy houses like this?"

"You idiots."

Bears are not affected by「The Three Little Pigs」. Their physique was also much better than that of a wolf.

Moreover, crucially—

[The story 'A group who covet the throne of the Overthrown' continues its storytelling.]

The power of the 'brown bear’s story’ was formidable. It's usually a story about hyenas, but I never thought a brown bear would have it.

「The group that covets the throne of the Overthrown is a story in which the group becomes more powerful as the number increases.」

Perhaps because of the power of the story, the bears that had fallen were getting back up and attacking.

"We’re being pushed back!"

The southern prisoners who were fighting began to run away one by one.

As the battle line suddenly collapsed, the crane owner also screamed.

"Don't run away! Fight back!"

Once the battle line was broken, it could not be recovered and began to fall back to ruin. It's The moment when even the crane owner lost his fighting spirit.

"Aaaah! Not even one of them can pass by!"

Kyung Sein let out a loud cry and jumped up like a flying squirrel. [Way of the Wind] crushed the charging bears.

It was Cha Yerin who exploded the heads of the fallen bears.

Cha Yerin is more skilled at [Way of the Wind] than anyone else in the group.

She was decapitating the heads of all the bears with her kicks.

At that time, a bear hiding under the corpses of his colleagues took advantage and aimed at Cha Yerin's side.

The person who stopped him was Dansu ahjussi who came running like a tank.

With a loud bang, the bear with its torn body flew through the air.

"When we were all gathered together in the brick house, I felt like I was with my family…"

The speed is unbelievably fast for a turtle.

Dansu ahjussi grinned at me.

"I feel angry for the first time in a while."

At the forefront of the group was a man wearing a pitch-black coat.

"Don’t let anyone die. I won’t allow it."

Killer King added without looking back.

"Same goes for you, Kim Dokja."

「Way of the Wind created small storms throughout the battlefield.」

Until a few days ago, even dealing with the wolf harvesters was difficult for the group.

They were now pushing back Bear Beastmen that were several times their size.

Truly incredible growth.

The battle lines that had been pushed back quickly recovered, and even the brown bears began to retreat, unable to withstand wave after wave of attacks from the party. It got to the point where I thought maybe we could just push on like this.

[Gaaaa— you guys!]

The brown bear, hit by Killer King's bowgun in succession, roared in anger.

[Catch those guys first! Take away their masks!]

The bears, ignoring the attack, immediately blocked the group's escape route and rushed towards them.

I urgently shouted to my companions.

"Avoid everyone!"

We must not lose our mask here. If the mask is taken away, 'humanization' occurs again and the person is excluded from the scenario. Power is taken away.

[The 'Mask' exists to cover something.]

As if reading my thoughts, the brown bear spoke.

[Stagnation, weakness, neglect. Or the truth. The will to cover up a weak mind soon becomes a 'mask'.]

A brown bear wearing a half-mask looked at me and smiled evilly.

[Wearing a mask means hiding behind one's own deficiencies. You guys who wear masks without knowing that—]

The brown bear's eyes, which burst into flames, gave off a dazzling light.

[Rather, it is begging for attacks on its weak points.]

The first to suffer was Kyung Sein.

A mask is an item made up of stories.

The mask of Kyung Sein, who was attacked by the Bear Beastmen, cracked, and the story of the mask began to flow.

「Kyung Sein wanted to become strong.」

Kyung Sein 'mask' is a squirrel.

「He grew his small body and trained his muscles. He felt like if he did that, others wouldn’t look down on him.」

I remembered the muscular man wearing the [Judge Heewon] name tag.

「But can you really say that you have become stronger because of that?」

It seemed like Kyung Sein was shouting something as she stretched out her hand towards me.

The rushing bear trampled on Kyung Sein's hand.

The sound of something being torn apart.

"Sein-ssi!"

The first to jump among the bears was Dansu ahjussi. Dansu ahjussi, who charged like a cannon, curled up with his body holding Kyung Sein.

A story flowed from the broken mask of the man named Lee Dansu.

「I want to live a long time.」

The mask of Dansu ahjussi is 'turtle'.

「I want to live even a little longer.」

The image of Dansu ahjussi wearing a patient gown came to mind.

The moment I finally couldn't bear it anymore and was about to run towards them, someone grabbed my shoulder.

"I'll go."

It was Cha Yerin.

"Yerin-ssi."

"I'll look for a story about controlling bears."

Cha Yerin used [Way of the Wind] like an acrobat to break through the path and approach Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu.

A huge shadow appeared behind Cha Yerin.

"Yerin-ssi!"

The brown bear's huge front paw hit Cha Yerin's back. However, Cha Yerin, who crouched down with good timing, created a 'Snail House' and blocked the blow.

[Like this shell—]

As the brown bear with bright eyes continued to hit the snail house, the corner of the house broke and fell.

「I need a place to go back to.」

Cha Yerin's 'mask' is a snail.

「We also need a home.」

Her stories, which she had grown up with in an orphanage with her brother, were being cruelly crushed by the bear's paw.

It was Ye Hyunwoo who blocked that front step.

The brown bear growled.

[How dare you eat bamboo.]

The weight of the brown bear's front paw collided with Ye Hyunwoo's fist.

Ye Hyunwoo, who was exhausted, was easily pushed aside due to his physical strength. With the sound of air bursting, Ye Hyunwoo's body rolled around on the floor.

The brown bear spoke while trampling Ye Hyunwoo's chest.

[Kill it.]

The bears that rushed in bit Ye Hyunwu’s entire body.

A story flowed from Ye Hyunwoo’s torn panda mask.

「You must live faithfully.」

Ye Hyunwoo was always sincere.

「Only in this way can we survive.」

For a moment, I thought I knew why his mask was 'panda'.

「Only then can we avoid extinction.」

He was more planned and systematic than anyone else, but maybe he actually wanted to rely on someone.

「Actually, I don’t want to do anything.」

Peacefully, quietly eating bamboo like a panda that can only live in a zoo.

"Is he going to lie down so pitifully?"

[Tsk—]

The shadow that flew in in an instant blew away the brown bear that was trampling Ye Hyunwoo.

"Breaking the Sky Crumble Fist!"

The startled brown bear backed away in horror.

[What-]

"Red Pheonix Shimpo! Breaking the Sky Kendo! Breaking the Sky Meteor Strike!"

Killer King, who arbitrarily used Yoo Joonghyuk's technical names, was pushing the brown bear with [Way of the Wind].

"Meteor Cham!"

[Wolf bastard—!]

The brown bear roared and hit Killer King on the head.

"Psst", a story flowed from the broken Killer King's mask.

「I am a lone wolf.」

The brown bear laughed as if it was dumbfounded by the story that was being told.

[Foolish wolf, stop back. All your colleagues are finished.]

"My colleagues."

Killer King said, wiping the blood from his lips.

"They will barely die like this."

[Your companions have already become beasts. And you too—]

The huge brown bear's fist moved rapidly. Before he could stop it, Killer King's mask began to break apart.

「I will become a beast.」

Losing one's mask means becoming a prisoner.

The moment I finally couldn't stand it anymore and took a step forward, Killer King shouted.

"Don’t come, Kim Dokja! This is our story!"

I stopped walking.

"Don’t make us feel horrible anymore!"

[You idiot.]

The brown bear laughed. The bear's fists hitting Killer King's face became faster and faster.

Hit it down, get it down. Hit it, hit it again.

Killer King's wolf mask was disastrously broken. Nevertheless, Killer King did not kneel in the end.

I clenched my fists and felt the strange omens of a story rising around me.

I can't explain it well, but I had a feeling.

My companions will be fine.

The stories they had accumulated so far said so.

「"Hyunwoo, how much longer are you going to practice [Way of the Wind]?"」

「"Just one more hour!"」

「"Okay, then I have two hours!"」

「"I've already been there for three hours."」

The sound of wind blowing from somewhere.

「The group is now ready to take off their 'mask'.」

What is the purpose of masks?

The 'mask' in Zone 13 is an item that prevents the incarnation from 'being transformed into a beast'.

However, according to the 'Ways of Survival', that was not the only meaning of the existence of 'masks'.

「The 'mask' exists for the moment when the face hidden beneath the 'mask' is revealed.」

Killer King's face was revealed through the broken mask. Killer King, with his lips burst, grabbed the brown bear's fist.

"Wearing a mask means."

It's been a while since I saw Killer King — Cha Sungwoo's bare face, his lips smiling wryly.

"It means you want to hide something."

The mighty brown bear retreated.

[How… You! The mask would have been broken—]

"Why don’t I become a beast?"

When a person sheds a mask and becomes an animal, it is a type of immune response used by a person with exposed weaknesses to protect themselves.

Nevertheless, Killer King did not become a beast.

That means—

"Because I realized that the world is full of people weaker than me."

[What nonsense—]

"There is no need to hide my weaknesses in front of those who are weaker than me!"

"Stupid, that’s not it."

Ye Hyunwoo woke up before he knew it and was standing next to Killer King. His mask was also broken.

The stories of the broken mask were being absorbed into his face.

"I learned that weakness can also be a 'story'."

"You could say that."

Suddenly, Cha Yerin walked out between the broken snail houses.

"You’re both wrong."

She, standing to the left of Killer King, had also taken off her mask.

"It’s because I gained comrades who will protect each other’s weakest parts."

Kyung Sein, standing on the mountain of fallen bears, shouted.

"You all speak well! Now that the mask is broken, I can see much better!"

With the mask gone, Kyung Sein’s expression looked much refreshed.

The man standing next to him also added a word.

"It’s like we are masks for each other."

The colleagues who had lost their masks stood tall like a breakwater and faced the waves of bears.

Seeing them like that made my heart pound too.

[An incarnation who realized the meaning of 'mask' has appeared in Zone 13!]

They have now proudly become the pillars of this world.

"I’m sure everyone hasn’t forgotten why we are here."

The group nodded one by one at Killer King’s words.

There was a group of people there, facing the stars with their backs to me.

Killer King said.

"I protect Kim Dokja."

I once again realize what my companions were fighting for.

「The Three Little Pigs, The Fox and the Crane, and again, The Goose that Laid the Golden Egg.」

While they re-enacted and re-enacted other stories, this was actually the story they wanted to re-create more than anything else.

[Your story resonates.]

What kind of face do I have?

Will my mask have a matching expression even if I am among them?

I thought of the person who should have seen this scene for me.

Let's remember this scene for him. Let's talk about it when we meet again someday.

There are people who have their own stories because of you.

"Kim Dokja."

Someone came and stood next to me. He, too, had lost his mask on his face. He also overcame the constraints of the mask.

It was natural.

Because he was someone who believed in his own story more than anyone else in this world.

"You guys."

The protagonist of this world.

A regressor who lost his memories and became a boy.

The eyes of the boy, who had grown a little taller in a short period of time, were watching the scene in front of him.

How does this scene appear through the eyes of a regressor who has gone through the same scenario over and over again?

"It seems like there’s something you want to protect."

I opened my mouth for a moment and then slowly nodded.

"Yes. Just like you did."

I saw the back of the group moving forward.

There are countless universes and even more planets.

One of those ephemeral planets.

Born in the same era, choosing one story out of many, reading it and liking it over and over again.

If such a thing is truly possible, the surprise certainly cannot be explained by words such as coincidence or miracle.

Because it cannot be explained, it finally becomes a story.

A story that fascinates the stars, sets the night sky on fire, and ultimately changes the universe.

[A new story begins to sprout in your group.]

The Constellations of this world call the story a tale.

[The possibility of a Nebula germinates in your group.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 744 Episode 30 Zodiac (6)

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The possibility of a Nebula.

I read the message over and over again.

My heart was beating deeply. Even though there is no incarnation that has become a Constellation yet, there is a 'possibility of a Nebula'.

Perhaps this is also the influence of the newly developed story?

The voices of the group rejoicing were heard from afar.

"They say a new story is sprouting?"

"This can’t be—"

"It was worth including a panda every time I repaired a story fragment."

"Is it really because of that?"

This is a story that neither I nor Han Sooyoung can write.

It was a story that was not found in 'Ways of Survival' or 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' and could only be created by those who read it.

The story was now slowly sprouting before our eyes.

「People who wanted to see the story of a very 'big house'.」

I felt certain that it was fate.

Someday I will transcribe their stories. The emotions and scenery of this moment will be sketched out in crude sentences.

I held on to 'Unbreakable Faith'.

"Yoo Joonghyuk, please protect the brick house."

For the story that will be written someday, I must hold the sword now.

We must protect this moment.

As I slowly blinked, the sound disappeared from my ears. Instead, all I could hear was the sound of stories talking.

[Exclusive attribute effect activates!]

Some stories were familiar and some were unfamiliar. There were disturbing stories, and there were also sad stories.

「I hate pandas」

「I want to be like a panda too」

「All you have to do is defeat the southern guys and steal their stories.」

「Actually, I don't want to do that.」

And there was a story floating around about bears.

A story that incites the bears' desires.

[Story fragment 'Fanning' continues its storytelling.]

「Fanning.」

It was the identity of the story fragment that moved the bear beastmen.

Someone must have used this story fragment to fuel the bears' desire and lead them here.

I looked closely at the way the fragments of the story had been spread.

While the Constellation 'A bear that saves Ones life if Onepretends to be dead' and other bear beastmen are all affected by this 'story fragment'—

「There was one bear that was unaffected by this 'story fragment'.」

The moment our eyes met, he turned his back to me and started running away.

[The item 'Sylphid's Leap Boots' activates!]

[The item's performance is halved due to the scenario effect.]

It doesn't matter if it's halved.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' opens its eyes!]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' admires your judgment!]

Fortunately, he wasn't that fast.

Dead end street.

Without hesitation, I swung my 'Unbreakable Faith' at him. With a popping sound, the bear's appearance changed.

There was a 'rat' the size of a small child.

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' is looking at you!]

「The zodiac.」

It was definitely true.

He is a 'rat', one of the Chinese zodiac animals, belonging to the 'characters'.

I tensed and held the hilt of the sword tightly.

If that is really the <Zodiac>, it must be a Constellation of at least Historical-grade level.

The 'bear that will come back to life if you pretend to be dead' that was talking in the vacant lot was also a Constellation, but it was not of the level of a proper Historical-grade.

But the <Zodiac> is different.

A proper 'Historical-grade Constellation'.

It was a difficult opponent for me now. All kinds of thoughts flowed quickly through my head.

I expected that the <Zodiac> was related to this matter, but I had no idea that the Constellations from the <Zodiac> would be there in person.

Should I run away?

Or should I give it my all and give it a shot before it shows its true power?

What if we use stories?

What if we use Kim Dokja's story from 「Heir of the Eternal Name」?

Or-

[Now, wait a minute—]

Unexpectedly, it was the rat who spoke first.

[Don't hurt me! I didn't come to fight!]

"What?"

Something was strange.

The use of mantras and indirect messages, as well as the sensations felt, were clearly from a Constellation. But the Constellation barely has this level of status?

[I was just watching! I'm curious about what kind of guys you are—]

If you think about it, it was strange that a proper Constellation appeared with its incarnation in tow, but there was no repercussions.

This is the eighth scenario area. If a 'Historical-grade Constellation' had unleashed its true power, the scenario should have exploded a long time ago.

However, there were no signs of a probability aftermath in the surrounding area.

"Don't lie."

[It-it’s true!]

After buying some time by saying something, I observed the guy.

The incarnation of the 'Nail-Eating Rat' is a small, small rat.

No matter how much I tried to sharpen my senses, I could barely feel any fighting power. At this level, it was safe to say that it was almost below a symbolic body.

What is his purpose? Why on earth did he appear here in such an incarnation?

I narrowed my eyes.

The scream of a brown bear was heard behind me.

Finally, the group began to herd the bears. I said, looking back at the bodies of the dead bears.

"That’s what you guys did. You used story fragments to control the bears. Are you going to act like a fool?"

[Well, that might be so! But I didn't order it! I swear!]

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' shouts that it is real!]

A strangely fearful 'Nail-Eating Rat'.

I glared at that guy and said.

"You didn’t do it?"

The 'Nail-Eating Rat' nodded enthusiastically.

"Then why were you here?"

[I told you earlier! I just want to see you in person—]

"Say it straight."

As I took a step closer and aimed with 'Unbreakable Faith', the 'Nail-Eating Rat' made a 'hissing' sound and quickly continued speaking.

[Yes, actually, I came to ask for an alliance. You guys are also going up to the next 'floor', right?]

"Alliance?"

The eyes of the 'Nail-Eating Rat' rolled to both sides.

[You guys are planning to fight against the Zodiac. Right?]

"You are also part of the Chinese zodiac."

[That's true, but I'm a little different. So, I…]

At that moment, I had a strange feeling.

Rat eating fingernails.

Come to think of it, this Constellation was one of the Constellations that had been watching us from the beginning.

A Constellation that even appeared in my 'behind the scenes selection'.

In other words, this guy has been watching the story of me and my companions for a very long time.

That means.

"You-"

A puzzle that slowly comes together in my head.

There were several Constellations that showed behavior patterns that were clearly different from 'Ways of Survival' or 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' that I had suspected from the beginning.

The 'Nail-Eating Rat' was one of them.

The 'Nail-Eating Rat' must have found some hope in my tone of voice and shook his head fervently.

[Yes, that's right. I am also like you. Me too.]

The guy with his eyes tightly closed seemed to have decided on something and started talking.

[I am a reader like you—]

"I found you, Kim Dokja."

A voice that flutters cold blood. Killer King was there, covered in bears' blood.

Killer King spoke while aiming a bow gun filled with black magic power.

"Get out of the way. I'll kill that rat."

[Heeeeeeeeek!]

The rat, startled, quickly hid behind me.

I continued speaking while stopping Killer King.

"Wait a minute, Killer King-ssi. This is—"

"The 'Nail-Eating Rat'. He is from the zodiac."

"I know that, but he—"

"Possessed people like us."

As if he already knew, Killer King did not withdraw his bowgun. An unusual anger was boiling all over his body.

"This guy is the 'Misreading Association'."

Misreading Association?

"Have you already forgotten what happened at the Edge of Darkness?"

I didn't forget. Of course I remembered it.

The place where I first met the Killer King siblings. There, I fought against the incarnations sent by the Constellations of the Misreading Association.

The guy who sent those incarnations back then was also a 'rat'.

[Oh, no. I am not a tyrant! Really!]

"It's a lie. They know we can't use [Lie Detection] here, so they're deceiving us."

[Because it's not! It's really unfair!]

"I saw you exchanging indirect messages with the Misreading Association Constellations in the past."

At Killer King's words, the 'Nail-Eating Rat' once again rolled its eyes.

[Oh, no. Is it so. I did talk to them a bit! But really, I’m not from the Misreading Association!]

"Questions and answers are useless. Die."

[Eeeeeek!]

The moment I thought about whether I should stop Killer King, the white-faced 'Nail-Eating Rat' crouched down and shouted.

[Shit! It's ruined! The 'Misreading Association' you know is already ruined!]

For the first time, Killer King stopped moving.

"What does that mean?"

[After all, there is no such thing as the 'Misreading Association' that you know! So, stop targeting us!]

If you look at it that way, the Constellations on the side of the 'Misreading Association' have not been visible at all recently.

Killer King, who had been staring at the guy for a while, slowly lowered his bowgun.

"Explain."

The very excited 'Nail-Eating Rat' started saying things like "This is why I didn’t want to come" and then started crying and screaming.

[I feel really unfair. I didn't really do anything! I'm not the one who moved the beastmen! I, I just want to let you guys know, how much I—]

It was at that time that I heard a thump and a vibration echoing from somewhere.

[How much, how much, ah, ah, ugh—]

The 'Nail-Eating Rat' that was licking its lips suddenly started violently eating its own fingernails.

[Oh, it’s coming. Come. He's coming. The guy is coming.]

What?

[Woa woa woa woa woa woa woa woa woa woa woa woa woa.]

The 'Nail-Eating Rat'’s eyes turned white and he soon collapsed.

Killer King checked the guy’s pulse.

"He’s not dead. But—"

"Something is strange."

The sound of weapons that filled the vacant lot until the end of the war could not be heard at all. The screams and shouts of the prisoners disappeared.

Killer King and I ran toward the clearing.

The prisoners waving their weapons at each other were still there.

They all had their weapons laid down on the floor, their heads buried in the ground, and their palms turned toward the sky.

As if they were worshiping their god.

Even the 'Bear That Spares One's Life if One Pretends to be Dead' was lying quietly on the floor as if he were dead.

A disturbingly strange sight.

"Kim Dokja."

Killer King’s voice trembled.

He was looking at the sky and pointed at something with his finger. A swirling portal was visible high in the sky.

The portal to the upper floor was open.

It was a portal that also appeared in「The Three Little Pigs」. At that time, the symbolic body of the pig Constellations came through that portal.

So what happened this time?

I heard someone approaching from behind.

【Student.】

Lycaon, who had always been in the lotus position while maintaining a small incarnation, returned to his original form.

【Run away right now.】

And then, from somewhere, I started hearing a story.

「…"I won’t eat you."」

A voice from a very old story.

「...delicious.」

I felt a chill as if someone had grabbed my heart.

So far I have met several Constellations. I fought against an Outer God, and even saw 'Ares', a Narrative-grade Constellation.

So, deep down, I thought I wasn’t afraid of things like the Chinese Zodiac.

However.

「Give me a piece of rice cake.」

The moment I saw the shadow of a huge Constellation that seemed to be about a hundred meters tall, I cursed my poor imagination.

Above the distant shadow that covered the ground, glowing red eyes were looking down at us.

Is that really a <zodiac sign>?

「I won’t eat you.」

Its pattern burns like a flame.

A story heard occasionally and intermittently.

I thought I knew who this guy was.

A shadowy pressureslowly raised its head towards me.

Sparks exploded violently in the air, and cold sweat formed on the back of my neck. I felt like my heart was being squeezed and blood was flowing from my nose.

I knew it instinctively.

「That is God.」

There was a Historical-grade Constellation that descended in a form close to its true body.

But how?

How was it possible for that Constellation to descend to this place, where even the pig Constellations had to come as symbols?

It was impossible without a probable cause.

「Probability justification.」

I raised my head, biting my lip. The guy's eyes were right in front of my nose.

"The Tiger Eating Rice Cakes…"

Only then did I realize.

The reason he was able to come here.

"Do you want to take me to the 'Zodiac Ball'?"

It was because of me.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 745 Episode 30 Zodiac (7)

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The <Zodiac> appears often in 'Ways of Survival', and has clashed with Yoo Joonghyuk several times.

A representative example is the '137th Round'.

However, in order to talk about what happened in the 137th Round, we cannot help but mention the 136th Round first.

As any reader who has succeeded in re-reading the novel like Killer King more than two times knows this, in the 136th Round, Yoo Joonghyuk fights and wins against the 'Dream Eater', an 'Outer God'.

「"I have become stronger."」

To be precise, it wasn't a proper fight, but a one-sided fight, and Yoo Joonghyuk's psychosis broke out — and that psychosis infected the 'God of the Other World', and he won by luck.

But no matter how you win, a win is a win.

The story remains.

[The story 'The One Who Murdered a God of The Other World' begins its storytelling.]

And that was the beginning of the 137th Round in question.

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' is glaring at incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk.]

[The Constellation tells you to attend the 'Zodiac Ball' if you want to clash with the 'Plague-Carrying Rat'.]

It was a provocation that he would not normally respond to. However, in the 137th round, Yoo Joonghyuk had defeated the 'Dream Eater', a deity from another world, and his liver had come out of his stomach (this is Han Sooyoung's expression), and although he usually did not avoid fights, he did not avoid it even more this time.

As a result, Yoo Joonghyuk falls into a trap at the 'Zodiac Ball' and is lynched to death.

The last thing the dying Yoo Joonghyuk saw was a rabbit stealing his liver and a rat eating his fingernails.

There is no way to know whether the 'Nail-Eating Rat' lived under the guise of Yoo Joonghyuk after that, but there is one clear lesson.

「"A Historical-grade Constellation is also a Constellation."」

The final lesson left by Yoo Joonghyuk in the 137th Round, where his liver and fingernails were torn off.

「So, if you encounter the true body of the Constellation, run away at all costs.」

It was exactly the advice that is valid for me now.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is looking into you.]

A pitch-black shadow covered Zone 13.

At one edge of the shadow, the outline of a tiger was slowly revealed, as if its skin was peeling off.

A height reminiscent of an alpine mountain.

Two red eyes hanging from the top of the mountain were observing me.

They look as if they are carefully examining whether the product they ordered arrived safely and whether there are any stains or scratches.

After a suffocating silence, the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' smiled as if he was satisfied.

[Have you finally arrived?]

The moment I heard the voice, I felt very sick to my stomach.

Yoo Joonghyuk was right.

A Historical-grade Constellation is also a Constellation. A being who built great stories and became a star in the sky.

And this was the true voice of a 'Historical-grade Constellation'. If you were an ordinary person, the moment you heard it, your head would explode.

The reason my companions and I were safe was because the stories we had built up so far were not easy.

"Dokja-ssi, what is that—"

When Kyung Sein opened her mouth, Ye Hyunwoo put a finger to his lips as if to stop her from interfering.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' smiled strangely, as if he was amazed at us.

[My little bean sprout, you have grown a lot during this time.]

It was an unpleasant expression.

[Now it will be about a small section.]

Is that a joke from the days of 「Sun and Moon」?

Only then did the frozen companions regain their composure one by one.

It seemed that the newly appeared Zodiac sign had no hostility towards us.

That's because with the appearance of this guy, the bear beastmen also stopped their activities.

[I waited for you for a long time.]

I surveyed the atmosphere and tried to say something.

"For all the waiting you've been waiting for, there hasn't been any response lately."

A lot of time has passed since I entered the 'Recycling Center'. Meanwhile, I took first place in the 'Zodiac Race', cleared 'The Three Little Pigs', and defeated the Pig Constellation Brothers.

But while all these things were happening, 'The Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' never once cheered for me.

Even though this place is the home of the <Zodiac>.

Still, it was a Constellation that I believed I had personal exchanges with, so I felt a little disappointed.

Above all, I received support for the 'core of the demon race' in the beginning, and I wanted to say thank you if possible—

[Little one, why did you choose Zone 13?]

A tone that doesn't seem like joking at all.

If you think about it, I had always communicated with him through 'Indirect Messages', so there was no way to know his actual personality.

'The Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' didn't wait for my answer and shook his head to himself before continuing.

[Well, it doesn’t matter. You just have to change the area.]

"Change areas?"

[There is no more time to devote to children's play.]

The Tiger Eating Rice Cakes lightly waved its hand in the air as if it was annoyed.

Then the high portal in the sky swirled, emitting bright light.

[Come with me. I will be your sponsor.]

It's literally a Constellation-like tone and a Constellation-like suggestion.

I opened my mouth nervously.

"I already have a sponsor."

Even though he's in a moribund state and out of contact, and is hardly helpful even when he's not in a moribund state and out of contact, that kind of sponsor is definitely still my sponsor.

So I just can't betray him over something like this. I have no intention of betraying him in the future.

[The synchronization rate with the sponsor increases.]

The tiger twitched his lips as if he was very displeased with that fact.

[That doesn’t matter. Because I want to be your 'supporter', not your 'sponsor'.]

"What does that mean?"

[You will be my agent in the next 'Zodiac Scenario'.]

The 'agent' of the following scenario.

I don't know, but what is certain is that the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is looking for an incarnation to act on his behalf in the next scenario.

If that were the case, the hilt of the sword was on this side.

"Sorry, but I have a scenario to clear in Zone 13."

[If you come with me, you don’t have to worry about such miscellaneous scenarios.]

A system message came from the air along with a humming sound.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' activates the power of the zodiac.]

[The agent selected by the Constellation, 'Tiger' can omit the sub-scenario of the 'Recycling Center'.]

I had an ominous feeling.

Wait for a sec. Are you 'omitting' the scenario I've played so far?

The moment when a bright beam of light flashed from the tiger's huge right hand.

[No, no, no, no.]

A timid mantra was heard from behind. A faint and pale mantra that cannot be believed to be from the same Constellation.

[Go, go, you can't go…!]

Rat eating fingernails.

The gaze of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' that was looking at me moved slowly. The rat that was sticking its head out from behind me hastily lowered its head. The rat's tremors were clearly transmitted through my back.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' opened its mouth. His true body, half covered in shadows, flashed white fangs.

[The rat was hiding in a place like this.]

A mantra full of life. It was hard to breathe, as if my heart had been bitten.

[I should have killed him right away. This will be your grave.]

"Wait."

I stood protecting the 'Nail-Eating Rat'. The eyebrows of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' arched.

[Little one, what are you doing?]

The atmosphere was becoming increasingly hostile. I swallowed my saliva as I watched the story slowly boiling over.

In fact, it was not a situation for me, a mere incarnation, to step forward. Because 'Nail-Eating Rat' was also one of the <zodiac signs>.

Is that it? In the main story, the 'Nail-Eating Rat' was one of the Constellations that tormented Kim Dokja and eventually died.

However, if I remember correctly, at least in this episode, the 'Nail-Eating Rat' was not a bad guy.

「[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' sponsors you 100 coins.]」

This guy has been rooting for me since the beginning.

「[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' agrees with incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]」

There were times when he helped Jung Heewon wake up or lent his hand when I was lacking in probability.

And crucially, he had information that needed to be heard regarding the 'Misreading Association'.

"Tiger Eating Rice Cakes. You probably don’t plan on revealing your status here."

Isn’t this enough reason for me to take a little risk?

"You probably don’t know who’s here."

With a wink of my eye, my faithful escort — Lycaon Isparang, the first wolf, appeared.

【Step aside, Zodiac.】

A presence that brings silence to the area just by uttering a single mantra. Even though he couldn't use his full power because of his contract with me and all he could do was flop around like a wind puppet, he was still a god of another world.

Tsutsutsu…

To be honest, I was very grateful just to help with Mantra. This is because uttering this kind of mantra itself was likely burdensome to Lycaon.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' glares at the 'Lost Guide'.]

As expected, the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' seems to be concerned about Lycaon's presence.

Lycaon has already defeated the symbol of the pig Constellations. Even the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' would not want to take unnecessary risks.

At least as far as I know, everyone in the Chinese Zodiac is a coward.

But there was something I didn't know.

For example, in the 137th round of 'Ways of Survival, Yoo Joonghyuk said this.

「When the opponent is the 'weak', the zodiac guys become horribly persistent predators.」

[Do you think I am a fool?]

Surprisingly, the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' seemed completely unfazed by Lycaon's presence.

[If that guy could use his strength, he would have helped you when the bears came.]

It was the perfect answer.

[In order for the 'Divine God of the Other World' to exist in this low-level scenario, a contract with absurd contents must have been signed. I already know that he can't move.]

I never thought everyone would have guessed what the 'Otherworldly Covenant' was about.

[Your cleverness has been sufficiently proven, so I hope you will stop playing.]

Honestly, I was surprised.

It's not the 'Reclining Dragon,' but is it really the Tiger Eating Rice Cakes?

Although I was a single-minded man who had no choice but to back down, I responded without losing my composure.

"Even if Lycaon can’t fight, it’s the same. If you really use your power, there will likely be repercussions. If I stop you here—"

[My actions are extremely probable. Didn’t I already tell you?]

Tinnitus rang in my head. A story that is still told in real time.

「If you give me a piece of rice cake, I won’t eat it.」

Only then did I understand the meaning of this 'story'.

[I just came to receive my 'rice cake'.]

With his declaration, a system message came to mind.

[You have signed a contract with the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.]

[You received the 'Demon Core' in return for the contract.]

[You must attend the 'Zodiac Ball' in return for the 'Demon Core'.]

I never would have guessed that the promise at that time was replaced in the form of a 'contract'.

Perhaps this is the ability of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

In order to lower my guard, he gave me a much-needed item, but on a condition that seemed relatively trivial.

To hide that this is a 'contract'.

[Do you understand now, little one?]

Now I have to attend the 'Zodiac Ball' without any hesitation.

Although I felt a bit displeased with suddenly becoming his agent, there was honestly nothing I couldn't do.

The problem is this.

If I leave, will the remaining party members be able to clear the scenario on their own?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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[Your approval rating drops.]

[Currently, 62% of prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

Honestly, it seemed like it would be difficult for the group to clear the scenario on their own.

There are two reasons.

One, if I leave out of this scenario, there is a high possibility that Bihyung will no longer cooperate.

Then, we will not be able to display the 'stories' we have changed outside of the Recycling Center!

Second, even if Bihyung cooperates, there are many stories that cannot be recreated without my 'mask', which can transform into another animal.

If it is impossible to stage the story, the party members can no longer increase their approval rating through 'mending the stories'.

The conclusion is clear. For the sake of my companions, I must remain here.

It was then that Killer King opened his mouth.

"Go, Kim Dokja. Just me is enough here."

A somewhat resentful voice. His tightly clenched fist was trembling slightly.

"Go first. Go and wait for me."

"Killer King-ssi is right."

Kyung Sein also added a word.

"You can go first. The big crisis has passed. Even the bears seem to have given up. And did you see it earlier? We also have a story!"

"It’s not like we’ll never meet again."

Dansu ahjussi also helped.

Cha Yerin, who was standing next to me, also nodded and said.

"You can trust us."

The only one who didn't say anything was Ye Hyunwoo. For some reason, Ye Hyunwoo glanced in my direction and lowered his head without saying a word.

I looked at Ye Hyunwoo like that and slowly closed my eyes.

Trusting my companions is definitely one way. If they were the ones they are now, they might actually be able to do it somehow.

Even if I fail, I can become the agent of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' and successfully carry out the next scenario, and come back to find my companions.

But if that happens, what happens to the stories we have built here?

Our story built up through 「The Three Little Pigs」, 「The Fox and the Crane」, and 「The Goose That Laid the Golden Egg」.

The time we built up step by step to confront the <Zodiac>, where we cast pandas and wolves and gathered in a small brick house to plan the next 'story'.

"Dokja-ssi?"

Anyone can see that following the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was the better choice.

We know that what the incarnations want is to have powerful sponsors backing them, compete quickly on a wider stage, and gain rewards.

Still, the reason I hesitate is—

"Tiger Eating Rice Cakes."

This is because I am called 'Kim Dokja' by these people.

"What I promised was to 'attend the Zodiac Ball', not to be your 'agent'."

Kim Dokja became a Constellation himself because he did not want to be an afterthought.

For Kim Dokja, who tried to solve all problems by building up his own stories, this was not a matter of choice.

"I’m sorry, but I will decline your offer. I and my companions will attend the 'Zodiac Ball' on our own."

"Wait a minute, Dokja-ssi!"

"And according to our contract, I’m free when I attend the 'Zodiac Ball'."

I continued speaking firmly without avoiding the gaze of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

Even though the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' had a different personality than I thought, I believed that if I said it this way, he would have understood.

Because.

「The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is definitely a 'reader'.」

It had to be that way.

If the 'Nail-Eating Rat' is a reader, then the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' must also be a reader.

He is the one who has been watching us along with the 'Nail-Eating Rat'. I believed that if he were a reader who was not a member of the 'Misreading Association', he would definitely understand what I meant.

[No, no, no, no, no.]

The rat hiding behind my back trembled and said.

[Run away, run away, run away.]

A violently scurrying rat dragged my sleeve. The rat pointed at the fallen bears with a trembling finger.

Something came to mind later.

「Who is the Zodiac member that led the bears here?」

I turned my head and looked up at the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

Very slowly, goosebumps rose from my toes.

[Your exclusive attributes are extremely active!]

A story that I could not read because I was momentarily overwhelmed by the presence of the Constellation.

'Story fragments' that encouraged the bears' desires and fueled them.

[The story has been interrupted by a story fragment 'Fanning'.]

I could now clearly see where the 'story fragment' originated.

"Tiger Eating Rice Cakes, did you send the bears here?"

I didn't want to believe it.

The indirect messages he had sent to me appeared in my mind one after another.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' agrees with the intentions of incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

He understood Jung Heewon's desire to protect what was precious to her.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' says that you only need to attend the 'Zodiac Ball' once in the future.]

He even sacrificed a huge amount of probability to give me the 'core of the devil species'.

I didn't want to believe that such a Constellation would have done something like this, that he would have done something that would put 'readers' like him in danger.

"Why-"

An answer I can't help but hear even if I don't want to believe it.

[Story fragment 'Fanning' stutters the story.]

His tale spoke for him.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' sent bears as scouts to watch Lycaon's movements. And he sacrificed them mercilessly.

The tiger's mouth opened as if spitting out rotten rice cake.

[Are you seriously asking why? Do you think that even small things like this require probability?]

Is the person with the wide-open smile really a 'reader' who has read the same story as our group?

[Little one, this is something your small head cannot understand. Don't think. All you have to do is hold on to the rope I hold out.]

Maybe it wasn't my mistake from the beginning.

The old stories surrounding him spoke on his behalf.

[Legendary story 'The Old and Sick Guardian Deity' mocks your faith.]

[The story 'The Evil Beast' laughs at you.]

[The story 'The One Who Calls The Spear' roars.]

[The story 'A Monster That Eats Humans' is looking at you.]

[The story 'The Owner Of The Rotten Rope'’s eyes shine.]

…

The soul of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is nowhere to be seen in these stories, of which we cannot even tell how old they are. His soul, faintly visible through the gaps in the thickly covered stories, is simply,

[Now it's time to leave.]

It was tiny, like a tiny slice.

"Dokja-ssi!"

The voices of my companions calling me became distant for a moment.

What looked like the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' stretched out its hand towards me.

The moment an irresistible force pulled my body in accordance to the contract, something shook off its power.

A warm and gentle breeze.

There was no need to ask who it was.

"Lycaon."

【Step back, student.】

I tried to speak.

You shouldn't get involved.

That is our contract.

And in this <Star Stream>, a contract is above all a sacred probability.

【It's okay.】

The entire Zone 13 began to shake.

[<Star Stream> detects the unexpected behavior of the 'Lost Guide'.]

[The management bureau controls unexpected situations.]

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was smiling.

[You're caught, you foolish monster from another world.]

The moment Lycaon's power overflowed, a message flew in from the air.

[<Star Stream> adjusts the scales of probability.]

The power of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was growing in proportion to Lycaon's power.

Tsutsutsutsu.

No matter how much the opponent is a 'historical-grade Constellation', Lycaon has shown his status here without any contracts or scenarios.

Even the status of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was stronger than expected.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' roars!]

A blow from the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' flew towards the incarnation body of Lycaon, which was shaking uneasily.

[Go away, monster from another world—!]

A huge rope was clamped in the tiger's mouth like a whip. As the tiger's head struck the top with all its might, as if turning its head, the rope flew in, creating a huge shock wave.

【Student.】

Lycaon threw his whole body to block the attack. As if protecting the only path allowed to him.

【There is not much space allowed to me. Because I am not the main character of this world. So, I will keep it short.】

I knew it instinctively. Now Lycaon is trying to tell me 'what should not be said'.

But why?

【The entity you are looking for is in the 'deep sea of ■■■'.】

"Lycaon, wait a minute! What is that—"

【Find other writers. Collect the world's disappearances, and—】

Lycaon's body was disappearing. His wind was disappearing. I extended my hand towards Lycaon.

【Become the 'Kim Dokja' you want to be.】

Lycaon's voice was scattering in the wind. His strong shoulders and magnificent mane were disappearing.

At the last moment, a faint smile appeared on Lycaon's face.

【Thank you for telling me your story. So, I will also tell you the last story.】

Lycaon's incarnation body was oxidized.

Beyond the bright blue smoke, the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was smiling.

I looked down blankly at the spot where Lycaon had disappeared. Something was sparkling there.

「SVRP. PW 041.」

Unusual object report.

[Way of the Wind has already been recorded in the object ■■■.]

It was a 'record' left by Lycaon, a recorder of fear.

「Suggesting direction for the complete restoration process of the object. The important thing is to 're-read'.」

Read again.

If it had been before, I wouldn't have understood what that meant. I would have answered that I had already read that sentence, that I had read it over and over again.

It was I who wrote that sentence, so I know that sentence better than anyone else.

But at that moment, I realized.

「A gale in my left hand」

'Re-reading' something did not mean 'reading again' what I knew.

「A storm in my right hand」

It is the same as 'transcendence'.

Just as Yoo Joonghyuk ascends to the transcendental throne with new enlightenment every time,

「In places where straight lines and curves collide」

I also have to understand sentences in a new way every time.

「The path of the wind will open.」

But how.

"Lycaon."

I smile bitterly and speak to Lycaon, who cannot hear.

"I still don’t know what that means."

What I understand is just the time Lycaon and Kim Dokja spent together.

A deep night when even the Dokkaebi King would have fallen asleep.

Lycaon often woke up and taught me [Way of the Wind], and when I couldn't find the answer, we talked about old times together.

【Student, but then in the dark castle...】

【Student, in the Holy Demon War...】

【Student, when the archangel closed the door on the ark...】

That's Kim Dokja's story from the past.

Lycaon mainly asked about Kim Dokja's feelings, so most of them were questions I couldn't answer.

I answered with the thought that I had become Kim Dokja. I imagined an answer that only Kim Dokja could give.

Strangely enough, if I keep answering like that,

【Okay. You did that.】

For some reason, I felt like Kim Dokja really was inside me.

【Thank you, student.】

As I look at the moon rising on the ceiling of Zone 13, I recall the last question Lycaon asked.

【By the way, student. Did you too... did you ever want to go home?】

A wolf's finger pointing to a large moon. Looking at Lycaon's eyes illuminated by the moon, I thought about him for the first time.

Lycaon before the scenarios begin. The wolves of Kronos running across the grassland. The wolf prince roared into the wind from the front.

Only then did I understand 're-reading'.

It doesn't matter what sentence is written there.

Reading something means reading the time added to that sentence. Estimating the time between lines accumulated while writing, reading, and imagining the sentence.

Understanding the time spent as a wolf running through a destroyed world, and responding to that time.

"Yes, I wanted to go back too."

It is not the sentence that changes, but the person who reads it that changes.

[You understand 'Way of the Wind'.]

The road has been opened.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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It wasn't a metaphor. The road was literally opening up before my eyes.

A pleasant tailwind that spreads throughout my body.

[Story fragment 'Way of the Wind' circles around you.]

Once I took one step, I could see where to take the next step, and where to take the next step.

This was [Way of the Wind].

Kim Dokja's main skill, as acknowledged by others, is No. 1.

With this skill, Kim Dokja took one step at a time and reached the end of the world.

[The story fragment 'Way of the Wind' nods.]

If someone had seen it, they might have asked if it was just [Way of the Wind]. But for me, the fact that I got as close to the 'Demon King of Salvation' with [Way of the Wind] alone was important.

[That power.]

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' looked at me and opened his mouth.

[Interesting.]

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' had an expression as if he were Yoo Joonghyuk from the 137th round, who defeated the Dream Eater.

[Is this a story fragment given to you by the dead wolf?]

"Lycaon is not dead. There is no way he could have been killed by a Constellation that was barely Historical-grade."

For a very brief moment, a slight agitation flashed across the 'Tiger''s face.

"Now, go back. I think you've had enough of bean rice cake or sirutteok."

[I'm still hungry.]

"You don't seem to know, but that's 'fake hunger'. It means you're not really hungry."

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is a Constellation that exists based on the story of 'The Sun and the Moon'. There are many mixed stories, but basically, he was a guy who tried to eat the main character's brother and sister, but failed and fell into a sorghum field and died.

Because he was unable to obtain what he wanted in the end, his story is full of resentment, hatred, and greed.

"If you fail to manage false hunger, you will experience accelerated aging. Don't you know?"

His thirst and hunger were both triggered by his stories.

[Little one, human life is too short to understand the Constellations.]

But what if the soul of an ordinary person suddenly possessed someone somewhere in the middle of the story?

"Since when were you a Constellation?"

Now I can see it. A small soul swaying slightly among the stories surrounding him. A small piece, or a soul smaller than soybean paste.

"I don’t know who you really were, but I ask you for one last time. Please get out of here."

That Constellation was a 'reader'. Even if not now, he was definitely a reader at least at one time.

That's why I endured that spirit just once.

"I will keep my promise to you. I will definitely attend the Chinese Zodiac Ball, but I cannot be your agent."

At the last moment, Lycaon spoke.

「Become the Kim Dokja you want to be.」

The Kim Dokja I want.

I don't know what that is.

Maybe that is not Kim Dokja, and maybe there is no such thing in the world.

However, if such a 'Kim Dokja' really exists,

"Leave from here immediately."

That 'Kim Dokja' will give the 'reader' in front of him one chance.

Of course, whether he would receive that opportunity was a separate matter.

Tsutsutsu, the ground in the area violently vibrated along with the sound.

Now that the 'scale of probability' has disappeared, the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' will not be able to show the power to astonish the world as before.

But it didn't seem like he would go away like this. Because he still had the justification of 'contract with me'.

[Do you think you have become someone great just by learning Way of the Wind?]

It was clearly a disparaging tone.

That's right.

He is indeed a 'Constellation' and [Way of the Wind] is at best a technique used to seal the 'Disaster of Questions'.

"Do you know much about Way of the Wind?"

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' stretched out his front paws into the air without saying a word. Then the blood-red rope tied to his front paw swirled and flew toward me.

I guess my patience ends here. Now I have to recommend 're-reading' to our readers.

[Your exclusive attribute is activated.]

[Your understanding of the story fragment 'Way of the Wind' is very high!]

I quickly rose to the level of the guy who was tens of meters tall.

Once, twice, three times, I can see where I need to step to accelerate faster. I accelerated and accelerated to the point where I couldn't even hear the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' shout.

At the end of that acceleration, there was 'Unbreakable Faith'.

Although the skill was sealed and I couldn’t use [White Blue Steel], it didn’t matter.

[The story fragment 'Way of the Wind' follows your will.]

「Way of the Wind was not simply a technique used to accelerate the body or fly through the air.」

Just as Kim Dokja used [Way of the Wind] to create a 'vacuum prison' to overcome the disaster of questions, there are endless ways to use technology depending on how you understand the wind.

[Little one, if you don’t stop right away—!]

The front paw of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' flew towards me precisely. I dodged the guy's front foot with a narrow trajectory, and then slammed 'Unbreakable Faith' onto his forearm.

An attack that would normally not work.

But now, [Way of the Wind] was wrapped around my 'Unbreakable Faith'.

Kuddddd.

The so-called [Wind Blade]. It was an application of Lycaon's enlightenment of constantly rotating using the drawings of straight lines and curves.

A story bounced from his front paw with a light sibilant sound.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' sighed briefly and opened his mouth.

[You have quite a bit of talent when it comes to small sections.]

I responded with a grin.

"You speak like a real Constellation."

[What?]

"Is there an academy that teaches how to speak like this? Or…"

[The story 'The old and sick guardian spirit' is angry at you!]

"Are you being controlled by that old story?"

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' exploded with the Tiger's Claws. It felt like a bomb made of sound was exploding across the sky.

「Way of the Wind was activated to its maximum level to simplify the impact.」

I fell to the ground, rolled around in the clearing, and then woke up. Blood flowed from the corner of my mouth.

Is it not possible yet?

Well, if just learning [Way of the Wind] would equal a Historical-grade Constellation, Kim Dokja wouldn't have gone through that trouble.

In any case, the provocation seemed to have worked well, as old stories from the predecessor of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' were running wild.

Did this buy me some time?

"Kim Dokja, what on earth are you thinking?"

Killer King, who flew in using [Way of the Wind], supported me and said.

"What you see is what it is."

I said, looking up at the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' running wild.

"I want to fight that guy and win."

"You are so crazy."

Killer King was silent for a moment.

He just lowered his head in exasperation and added a word while deliberately ignoring me.

"Sorry."

"What? I just chose this because it was more fun."

"...Because it’s fun?"

"Because it deserves to be more of a 'story'."

Kim Dokja said something similar every time he made an absurd choice.

Because this is more fun.

This is a development that the Constellations will be more pleased with.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' snorts.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' is surprised by your judgment.]

But was that really just a consideration of the Constellations’ gaze?

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' is worried about you.]

In fact, perhaps Kim Dokja himself wanted that development to unfold.

"Dokja-ssi."

"Yes."

Before I knew it, Kyung Sein had flown in and was standing next to me.

"Thank you."

Before I could answer, Kyung Sein burst out saying the words she had been holding back.

"I was so nervous because I thought you were really leaving us behind! Although I trust the other group members—"

"Aren’t we the people who gathered around 'Kim Dokja'?"

Dansu ahjussi also added his words.

Cha Yerin and Ye Hyunwoo also stood on either side of the group as if they agreed.

Killer King asked,

"What is the operation?"

"You just have to hold on for now. Until he becomes less probable ."

"Is that even a strategy?"

"I thought it was a plan worthy of Killer King."

I briefly conveyed the situation to my companions through [group chat].

It was about the 'invitation to the Chinese Zodiac Ball' that I and the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' had formed.

Killer King, who heard everything, said with admiration.

"I see. It’s a plan worth setting up."

"Yes?"

"But can that also be a probability of advent?"

I nodded and answered Kyung Sein's question.

"It’s a small probability. So, he won’t be able to stay strong for long. There’s no way he’ll be able to use his strength properly."

"What if you’re wrong?"

"Even if I’m wrong."

I continued, measuring the depth of the night sky.

"If we last until midnight tonight, we can win for sure."

"Midnight?"

[New sub-scenario has arrived!]

The sub-scenario had just arrived.

For some reason, it seemed like the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' didn’t react for quite a long time, and it seems like it was a precursor to the scenario.

**<Sub Scenario – Chinese Zodiac Race>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: S+

Clear conditions: Survive the zodiac sign 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

Time Limit: —

Reward: Unidentified story fragment, 300,000 coins, ???

Failure: Death.

The strategy goal is not 'kill' but 'survive'.

That meant that this fight was unfavorable to us.

At the beginning of the scenario, the 'Tiger' who calmed down the stories frowned.

[They are really annoying people.]

Although his tone is threatening, he is no longer able to launch powerful attacks in succession like before. No matter how likely it is that he came to keep his contract with me, there is no way he could cause an unreasonable hemorrhage like when he confronted Lycaon.

[The story 'The One Who Calls The Ghost' begins its storytelling.]

Nevertheless, he was still a 'Constellation'.

[Stand up, you devils.]

Changgui.

A term used since ancient times to refer to a ghost who died after being bitten by a tiger.

It was a similar story to the 「King of the Dead」 used by 'Davids', a ranker of the Dark Castle.

Oooooh!

The incarnations buried throughout Zone 13 began to rise one by one. The corpse-like incarnations turned their empty eyes towards me. They were all prisoners killed by tigers.

"Damn it, are they demons?"

"It’s similar. But I can’t use my original abilities properly."

Although there were a lot of them, looking at them attacking us, fortunately there were no strong incarnations.

I think it's still worth doing at this level...

[The story ′Compatible Mama' begins its storytelling.]

One of the prisoners that was standing nearby clutched his head as if he was frightened.

The moment I hurriedly extended my hand towards him.

"Save me—"

The beastman’s head exploded with a pop sound.

I got goosebumps.

He even used this story?

Tsutsutsutsu.

A white spark.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' had decided.

Even if he has to endure some repercussions, he will definitely end this scenario in the way he wants.

"Focus on the masks everyone is wearing!"

I shouted to my colleagues and prisoners.

「Compatible Mama.」

A story that refers to both the 'misfortune suffered by a tiger' and 'an epidemic'.

The characteristic of the story is 'fear contagion'.

Incarnations consumed by fear lose their ego and their heads explode and they die.

"We must spread the word and stop the spread of fear!"

Fear is ultimately the fear of the unknown.

To overcome fear, you need to redirect your gaze. I must listen to the stories that I know well and that make up myself.

[The story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear' nods.]

I was hardly influenced by「Compatible Mama.」

However, the situation seemed to be a little different for my colleagues.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 748 Episode 30 Zodiac (10)

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I grabbed the shoulders of my stumbling companions and shook them.

"Everyone, come to your senses! You can’t be eaten!"

The light was slowly returning to the companions' eyes, but the speed was too slow. At this rate, even if they overcome 「Compatible Mama」, they will be attacked by ghosts.

Then there is only one way.

I accelerated rapidly along the [Way of the Wind], punched the air, and rushed towards the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

「Compatible Mama is so powerful that when activated, the owner of the story cannot take any action.」

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is activated!]

In other words, I could give him a real hit now.

[Fragment of the story 'The Sword Master’s right hand man who was stabbed in the back by a colleague' opens its eyes!]

A story fragment written by the Demon King of Salvation.

The fragment of the very same story that slaughtered dozens of Historical-grade Constellations that had ascended to half their heights emanated light from my right hand.

「Way of the Wind, wrapped in 'Unbreakable Faith', once again caused a sensation.」

A sword attack that explodes leaving behind a white light pattern.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' caught my blow with his front paw.

[no use.]

I bit my lip tightly.

The fragments of Kim Dokja's story were not this weak.

How should I read it?

How do I 'read again' so I can fight like that guy?

Writing a story and writing down sentences did not mean that I fully understood the world.

Some understanding occurs by the reader.

Kim Dokja needed help.

"You always try to be the main character."

Killer King flew in from behind with [Way of the Wind] and fired his bowgun repeatedly.

Finally, the group overcame「Compatibility Mama」and joined.

"Aaaah! Take it! Turtle Crusher!"

Kyung Sein flew up like a flying squirrel and threw Dansu ahjussi in the air with all her might. Dansu ahjussi curled up like a turtle spun around like a top and flew in. A heavy blow exploded into the tiger's abdomen, and for an instant, a gap was opened for the [Way of the Wind] to penetrate.

[The story fragment 'Way of the Wind' resonates!]

[The story of 'Way of the Wind' begins!]

The moment the road opened, the hesitating stories began to talk.

[The story 'The Fox, the Crane, and the Wolf—often a Panda' begins its storytelling.]

The story we mended.

As the content changed, the story began to become known throughout the <Star Stream> again, finally gaining strength.

The plates and gourds used by the fox and the crane fell from the air like bombs.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' shouted in horror.

[You dare—!]

Afterwards, a flock of swallows flew from the sky and dropped Park-ssi.

[The story 'The Panda Saw the Swallow Carrying the Seed in its Mouth' begins its storytelling.]

The body of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' that stepped on Park-ssi tilted and shook. Without missing the opportunity, Ye Hyunwoo and Cha Yerin struck the back of the guy's knees. His huge body slowly lost balance and he fell backwards.

"Now!"

However, these stories are impossible to「stage」on our own.

"Whoever brings the head of the spearfish gets free soup!"

Since when did it start?

The crane owner was shaking the frying pan and hitting the heads of the spearfish .

The Goose That Lays Golden Eggs laid golden eggs on the heads of the spearfish, and the swallows dropped the gourd seeds and pecked the spearfish in unison.

It wasn't just them.

"Waaaaah!"

The prisoners from Zone 13, who had entrusted us with their stories, rose up like wildfire.

Prisoners who do not have weapons or proper stories to tell.

Nevertheless, they did not back down and fought back.

Those without weapons threw plates and gourds containing soup brought from the inn.

[The Constellation 'The bear that Spares One's life if One pretends to be dead' is embarrassed by the beastmen’s reaction.]

Only the bears were putting their heads down on the floor, unable to do anything.

At that time, something fell on the head of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' with a thudding sound.

"Hahaha! Look at that guy!"

The prisoners burst out laughing at the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' with hot soup on his head.

"What a tiger guy!"

The beastmen of Zone 13 were shouting excitedly, as if they had never been afraid of the Chinese Zodiac.

"You demons, go back to your graves!"

What moved them?

「The Three Little Pigs, The Swallow Carrying the Gourd Seeds, The Goose that Laid the Golden Eggs…」

Maybe all those stories piled up like snow and finally bloomed into a small container.

[The story of Zone 13 is with you!]

[Your budding story is evolving!]

What is certain is that the story of the fallen prisoners has been reawakened once again.

[The story 'Compatible Mama' cringes.]

A simple story built together was driving out a huge fear.

Stories may be forgotten, but they never disappear.

Although it is not a huge or mythical story, it is a story that has supported their daily lives.

The history of Zone 13 was finally being 'reread'.

"He’s down!"

"Cut off his head!"

The prisoners from Zone 13 began running toward the head of the fallen 'Tiger'.

"Wait! Stop!"

But that was a mistake.

[The story 'Sleeping Tiger’s Nose Hair' begins its storytelling!]

Some of the prisoners touched the tiger's nose hair.

The 'Tiger' rose up with a powerful roar and blew out hot breath.

The prisoners nearby were melted by the hot air that came with the terrible smell.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is furious!]

A fierce aftershock began to surround the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

When I looked closely, I saw something that looked like a shiny jewel embedded in his back. I immediately recognized what it was. That was the reason why the Historical-grade Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was so strangely strong.

"That was because he killed another 'reader'."

Ooooooh—!

Some prisoners, startled by the tiger's strength, ran away in fear.

But we didn't back down.

There was nowhere to retreat anyway.

[The scales of probability are moving!]

A force so strong as to tip the scales of probability. And there was no one here to help us.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' frowns at the topic of Historical-grade Constellation, calling it arrogant.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' awaits your operation.]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' attempts to intervene in the scenario!]

[The Constellation's intervention in the scenario was prevented by the Recycling Center's contract.]

Evaluators have no formal involvement in our scenarios. Because that is their viewing condition.

And there was no way the other Chinese Zodiac signs could help us.

[The Constellation 'Liverless Rabbit' tells you to trample on them quickly!]

[The Constellation 'Rat That Brings Plague' rejoices!]

[Some Constellations of the Nebula <Zodiac> are watching your end.]

[A few Constellations in the Nebula <Zodiac> say that the time has come to correct order in Zone 13.]

I looked at the sky.

There is certainly no Constellation in this world that can help us.

I took slow, deep breaths as if taking in the night sky. As soon as enough deep night air hit my lungs, I felt like my mind was waking up little by little.

"Kim Dokja!

Killer King and his companions stood protecting me.

The entirety of the bodies of the group members were full of big and small wounds, as if they had already been injured here and there. They were all attacked by tigers and ghosts.

"It’s impossible to keep going like this. There are endless bastards coming in."

As the legend of the tiger became stronger, the ghosts became more rampant. The war situation worsened as even the beasts that had just died began to be resurrected as ghosts. The screams of the prisoners in pain filled the night.

[The story 'The One Who Calls Spears' continues its storytelling.]

I know. If we continue to fight like this, we will lose.

"It's okay."

This is the same even if we kill all the spears.

It is impossible to fight against the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' who has started using the power of his true body. No matter how much we have built up stories, it is impossible.

But there are beings who can do that.

"It’s midnight now."

When I looked up, the Constellations in the night sky began to shine brightly.

There is a reason the day starts at midnight.

The time when all the sleeping Constellations wake up.

As I watched the bright stars turn their attention to the ground, I realized something again.

There are many reasons why we read stories. To reach the truth, to empathize with someone, to experience an unknown world, or—

To survive.

We read, we empathize with the characters and experience this world, live their lives, and feel their emotions.

But we know.

No matter how strongly we empathize with them, or even if we see the world from the perspective of an omniscient reader, we can never become the main character of that world.

We still don't know the feelings of the person who fights to survive more than anyone else.

"Ah."

When Cha Yerin, who exclaimed lightly, turned her head, the other party members also looked in the same direction at the same time.

In the darkness of the night, there was a man who had endured the night of this world for longer than anyone else.

Instead of the pitch-black coat that symbolized him, a shabby cape was fluttering about, but even so, he could not hide the unique atmosphere he gave off.

"Get out of the way."

A cool voice flowed through the shadows.

"From now on, I will deal with you."

No one could resist those words because they knew who he was. At the same time, my companions had to look at me because they knew who he was.

"Is that okay? He’s still a boy! And he’s lost all his memories!"

"It’s okay, because—"

I grinned as I saw the man walking at night.

"Exactly 'ten days' have passed as of today."

Yoo Joonghyuk's face brightened under the starlight. He no longer had the expression of a young boy.

Finally, the side effects of Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Story Imprint' ended and he returned to his adult body.

Nevertheless, my companions still seemed anxious.

"But no matter how much Yoo Joonghyuk is—"

"It’ll be okay. Trust me."

If it had been a normal 41st round, I would have had similar thoughts as my companions.

However, this '41st round' was not an ordinary '41st round'.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who is here now, is the transcendental figure who drove the giant Nebulae to destruction in only the 40th round.

As soon as the 41st Round started, he was a monster that smashed three-story engravings into his body and tore a Marquis-level Demon to pieces with a single sword.

As if to prove it, Yoo Joonghyuk walked forward, facing the gaze of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

Showing no fear or panic, it is truly the gait of a winner.

About a dozen spearfishes that rushed at him without realizing it attacked him. They oxidized like starlight before they even got close to Yoo Joonghyuk.

"The tiger of the zodiac."

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes looked up into space indifferently. A gaze that seems to be staring at a low mountain, and a voice that shows no emotion despite its tall stature.

"Killing you—"

The 'Sainsa Sword' I gave him glowed a distant light in his hand.

"This is the third time."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 749 Episode 31 Yoo Joonghyuk (1)

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「The universe suddenly began one day. No one knows what happened before that.」

Perhaps that is why the 'Oldest Dream' must continue to dream.」

—Lost guide

---

The group members expressed their admiration as they saw Yoo Joonghyuk step forward.

Perhaps my companions also remembered 'that line'. Yoo Joonghyuk said a similar line when he killed Poseidon.

"Oooooh!"

"It sounds like something I’ve heard before."

"As expected, it’s Yoo Joonghyuk."

"Ah."

"I can’t believe the day has come when I hear that in person."

Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Killer King, Cha Yerin, and Ye Hyunwoo took turns spitting out a word and looking back at me at the same time.

No one opened their mouths, but I could tell what everyone was curious about.

"So is that real?"

If you think about it with common sense, there is no way he could have killed a Historical-grade Constellation twice in just 41 rounds.

So that's why they're asking.

I nodded slightly. That's real. Because this '41st Round' is special.

"Oooh!"

As if she had received some sort of permission from my answer, Kyung Sein was excited and clapped her hands as she chanted his name.

"Yoo Joonghyuk! Yoo Joonghyuk! Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Dansu ahjussi also screamed in excitement.

Killer King nodded and muttered quietly.

"Go, Supreme King."

Amid the noisy cheering, Yoo Joonghyuk glanced towards us.

Seeing the line between his eyebrows, he must be in a bad mood.

Well, I think it would be burdensome if he suddenly received support like that.

Finally, his eyes turned to me. Afterwards, an [electric sound] was heard.

—After I kill that guy, it’s your turn.

Ugh, why?

There was a memory that suddenly came to mind.

「"Eat, you bastard!"」

Could it be because of being fed dirt?

But it's unfair.

I have never fed dirt to this guy. I just fed them the 'story of eating dirt'.

The guy who was controlled by the story picked up the dirt and ate it himself.

Damn, this is why I was hoping his memories would come back late.

Still, fortunately, it was a consolation to know that there was someone who would fall with me before me.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is wary of the incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

It was an unexpected reaction.

Under normal circumstances, this would have been an indignant moment, saying, "You're going to kill me when you're just an incarnation?" or rushing in, shouting, "You bastard, how dare you!"

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' glares at the incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk' with a cautious expression.]

He wasn't a 'reader' anymore.

Nevertheless, being so wary of Yoo Joonghyuk means that the stories that control him are conscious of Yoo Joonghyuk.

There is a possibility that he may have read the 'reader's' memories.

[Could you have become a transcendental being?]

Transcendent.

The only mortal title that can fight against the immortal Constellations in the <Star Stream>.

However, as I remember, Yoo Joonghyuk has not yet transcended. If he had 'transcended', a system message would have already appeared.

"I can defeat you even without transcendence."

[A mortal who cannot even transcend would dare to face the Constellations?]

That's right, you should come out like that.

Judging from the way he spoke, it seemed like the story 'old and sick guardian spirit' was active again.

The more he behaves like a stereotypical Constellation, the more likely he is to lose.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' roars!]

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is a Historical-grade Constellation that utilizes some of the power of his true body.

Although he was somewhat limited by probability, he was a more powerful being than the demon marquis he fought earlier.

So this time, Yoo Joonghyuk also has to do his best.

['Redemption of Truth' is activated.]

Without hesitation, Yoo Joonghyuk activated 'Story Imprint'.

[Part of incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk's memories are sealed.]

Redemption of Truth is a 'story imprint' that unleashes power at the cost of sealing some of the memories of the previous rounds.

Fragments of memories flowed into me as they were sealed before my eyes.

「"Leader."」

That is Yoo Joonghyuk's memory that was not written down in 'Ways of Survival' or 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

Yoo Joonghyuk's 24th round.

「"I have a favor to ask, Captain."」

The scenery of the wide sea shimmered and waves waved before my eyes.

Was it a scenario played out on the coast? Yoo Joonghyuk and Shin Yoosung were on the beach where the wreckage of broken ships washed up. The young girl had a large hole in her abdomen.

「"I want to go back to school someday."」

A wound that cannot be healed by either the 'Spirit of Elaine Forest' or the 'Great Hwandan'.

The girl hid the wound with her hand and pretended not to notice the wound.

Shin Yoosung held her breath in Yoo Joonghyuk's arms.

「"If this world ends safely—"」

Shin Yoosung also knows.

Schools will never reopen. Students will not return. She will never go to school.

「"Please come to the graduation ceremony."」

Even though she knew it all, Shin Yoosung had no choice but to say that.

Even though she knew very well what kind of eternity it would be remembered by Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk now answers that eternal question.

"I can’t go to your graduation ceremony, but—"

His 24th attempt failed. The world has been destroyed and past history will never return.

Shin Yoosung of the 24th Round did not graduate.

"I won’t let you die before me."

His memories were being sealed.

If it were the Yoo Joonghyuk I knew, he would never have sealed it. However, the more important memories are sealed, the more powerful the 'Redemption of Truth' is.

Now, Yoo Joonghyuk needs a 'power' that strong.

I stretched out my hand. I wanted to shout that those memories should not be sealed. If you forget that memory, the world will be as if it never happened.

But at that moment, my eyes met with Yoo Joonghyuk.

"I."

It may be an absurd leap.

There's no way Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round would think like that.

But now, Yoo Joonghyuk knew clearly that I was looking at his memories, and that I was the only one witnessing the memories he would lose.

"I want you to remember this memory for me."

I read and reread Yoo Joonghyuk's memories being sealed with my fists clenched. I remembered the disappearing Shin Yoosung and the 24th Round without missing a single word.

When I nodded, Yoo Joonghyuk turned his gaze.

[All comprehensive abilities of incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk' temporarily exceed the scenario limit standards!]

[Explosive power surges from your entire body!]

Yoo Joonghyuk took a leap forward with a tremendous energy. Magical power was overflowing from the guy's whole body.

Quad deud deuk!

Yoo Joonghyuk's rushing sword strike collided with the front paws of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

Yoo Joonghyuk lifted one seal from the Washington Dome and reached the same level as the 'Demon Marquis'.

But this time, that level of force is not enough.

[Just that much!]

While listening to the Constellation's planned message, Yoo Joonghyuk immediately opened the second narrative engraving.

[Incarnation 'Yoo Jonhhyuk' activates 'Restraint of Emotions'!]

Restraint of Emotions.

I'm nervous. This is because it reminded me of the 'Black Beast' that turned Washington Dome into hell.

At that time, there was the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

However, if Yoo Joonghyuk's transformation into a beast progresses this time, who can stop him?

—Do your part properly this time.

Yoo Joonghyuk's voice reached my ears.

A little belatedly, I remembered my promise with him. The reason he wanted to take me to the Washington scenario.

「"You stop it."」

He trusted that I would get him back to normal when he had a problem.

"I'll try."

A word I muttered without realizing it.

Killer King glanced in my direction. Fortunately, Yoo Joonghyuk's transformation began before Killer King could even open his mouth.

I watched his transformation with bated breath.

Will he become a 'black beast' again this time, or...?

[Incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk''s story engraving skill has increased significantly.]

['Restraint of Emotions' evolves!]

With a dazzling beam of light, pitch-black hair covered Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body. But this time he was not the 'black beast'.

The pitch-black hair grew in an instant, followed by a fur coat reminiscent of the [Beast Lord's sensitivity] used by 'Beast Lord' Shin Yoosung.

The difference is that Yoo Joonghyuk's fur coat was black.

Killer King, who was watching the scene from the side, widened his eyes.

"Long hair, fur coat… Could it be the Emperor of Heilang?"

Normally, I would have retorted to Killer King's nonsense, but this time, I was so overwhelmed by Yoo Joonghyuk's atmosphere that I couldn't think of anything else to say.

Wearing a black fur coat, Yoo Joonghyuk really looked like a prince of the demon world who reigned over ten thousand horses.

Maybe that is another form of the 'Black Beast'.

[How—]

While the story of the 'old and sick guardian deity' continued to lurk in secret, Yoo Joonghyuk's new form moved.

It's so fast that you can't even see it.

Even after learning [Way of the Wind], it was a speed that I couldn't follow with my eyes.

The astonished tiger screamed. However, neither the rushing spears nor the tiger's paws could catch Yoo Joonghyuk.

No story in this world could redeem Yoo Joonghyuk.

Breaking The Sky Sword Technique.

A skill that has been trained and trained to reach its peak.

In a sense, the 'Recycling Center' was his solo stage.

All of his techniques have gone beyond the level of 'skill'. In other words, it is not restricted by skill seals.

Breaking The Sky Meteor Strike.

A meteor blossomed in the swordplay of 'Sain Tragedy Sword'. Stars cried out above every trace of the sword.

"Gaaaaaagh!"

The ghosts hit by the meteor fragments disappeared into light.

Truly overwhelming force.

The meteor shower pierced every part of the tiger’s body like a storm.

[Kaaaaaa!]

The Constellation's scream spread throughout Zone 13.

[The Constellation 'Liverless Rabbit' opens its eyes in astonishment!]

[The Constellation 'Rat spreading plague’ is scared.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' holds his breath.]

The slowly moving front paw of the tiger. Yoo Joonghyuk did not miss the short gap and fired back and forth.

The sword dug into the hole pierced by the meteor shower, connecting the holes like connecting Constellations.

With the sound of something breaking, the tiger's front paw flew through the air.

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' is overwhelmed by the power of the incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' cannot take their eyes off incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

I felt a thrill amidst the ecstatic tales scattered throughout.

「A black wolf was hunting a tiger.」

There was no human feeling in the graceful movement of the sword. What was reflected in the trajectory was simply the time of hardship endured by Yoo Joonghyuk.

Memories of training his sword day and night to defeat the Constellations in the sky.

[K-keaaaa—my arm! My arm—how dare you—!]

All those memories were concentrated and summed up in a single body.

He narrowed the distance with the gait of [Red Pheonix Steps], blocked incoming blows with [Defense Strength], and dealt with the oncoming spear ghosts with [Hundred Step God Fist].

And cut the Constellation with [Breaking The Sky Swordsmanship].

Breaking The Sky Mad King’s Dance.

Dozens of sword lights pierced both legs of the tiger. One knee buckled, and then the other knee buckled again.

The huge tiger's body lost its balance and fell forward. Yoo Joonghyuk didn't let go of the opportunity and flew towards the guy's neck.

He was only on his eighth scenario.

In the eighth scenario, Yoo Joonghyuk was trying to accomplish the feat of dropping a Constellation from the sky with his own strength.

[The story 'Old and Sick Guardian Deity' disappears.]

[The story 'Rotten Dongajul' is activated in exchange for the 'Old and Sick Guardian Deity'!]

「Rotten Dongajul.」

The unique story of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' who escaped a desperate crisis.

[The story 'Rotten Dongajul' begins its storytelling.]

Although it was a similar technique to Nirvana's [No Possession], this story demanded a more terrible price than [No Possession].

Just before Yoo Joonghyuk's sword touched the guy's neck, a bright red fireball burst out from the tiger's chest along with the sound of fu-chem. Red snowflakes were scattered on the ground, creating a red sorghum field.

The image of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' began to disperse like smoke among the blood-stained sorghum fields.

[I am dissatisfied. Since I was unable to get the little one—]

The mantra of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' rang out as if he were sorrowful.

His gaze full of hatred that had been on me soon turned to someone else.

[I will take the other one.]

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 750 Episode 31 Yoo Joonghyuk (2)

Does he want to take the other one?

The moment I wanted to shout out what does that mean.

"Dokja-ssi, there—"

Kyung Sein’s voice.

We looked at the red sorghum field at the same time. Standing there was a person we knew.

"Why—"

Maybe I expected it. But I wasn't sure.

「Besides me, there was someone who signed a contract with the Tiger Eating Rice Cakes.」

Understanding, as always, came a little slowly.

It was only then that I realized why the Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' wasted a bit too much probability here.

「There were two incarnations that the Tiger Eating Rice invited to the 'Zodiac Ball'.」

"Hyunwoo-ssi!"

In the center of the red sorghum field, Ye Hyunwoo's whole body was shining brightly.

I jumped straight into the sorghum field with [Way of the Wind].

Tiger fur fluttering.

Ye Hyunwoo held out his hand as a sign not to approach.

"Hyunwoo-ssi!"

Ye Hyunwoo nodded his head as if he knew what I was going to say.

"I know it could be a trap."

Smart Ye Hyunwoo already knew. Even though he knew, he chose it.

When I was about to ask why, Ye Hyunwoo answered first again.

"I can't be who I want to be when I'm with you."

Ye Hyunwoo turned his gaze to behind me. There, a group of people with puzzled expressions were looking at us.

Killer King asked.

"Seventh Apostle. Are you really planning to make that choice?"

Normally, he would have said something, but today Ye Hyunwoo was a little different. It looks like he's smiling bitterly, or his face is contorted in sadness.

In the halo of light, Ye Hyunwoo's feet slowly began to disperse.

The summoning was carried out through the power of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

Finally, Ye Hyunwoo's eyes turned towards me as if he had decided on something.

"Actually, I'm not the type of person who is good at getting attached to people. You probably already know that."

I know.

Even Gong Pildu, who was part of the duo, felt that way.

"But for the first time, I felt like I knew what it meant to be affectionate."

Ye Hyunwoo, who was now half gone, was smiling.

"I'm scared now. I don't want to see someone dear to me die again. But I will see. We've entered that world. I mean—"

I realized what he was going to say.

"Kim Dokja will be me."

I understood why he wanted to become Kim Dokja. That's why I had to stop it.

But Ye Hyunwoo was almost gone now.

The moment the Killer King rushed towards Ye Hyunwoo, there was someone who moved before him.

When I looked up with an eerie feeling, I saw Yoo Joonghyuk, spouting pitch-black speculation, right in front of me.

Yoo Joonghyuk's palm was aimed at Ye Hyunwoo's disappearing neck.

[Puppet of the Oldest Dream.]

The voice of the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was heard. A voice with an ominous laugh somewhere in it.

[I will tell you the pain of falling in the sorghum field.]

A small explosion was heard in front of me, and then smoke filled the air.

The startled companions covered their mouths and backed away. But Yoo Joonghyuk and I were within the distance from where the smoke radiated.

[You have been exposed to 'poisonous fog'.]

Poisonous fog.

It was fortunate. Even though it is a deadly poison, you can survive this much for a while.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

I called Yoo Joonghyuk’s name in the fog. However, Yoo Joonghyuk was nowhere to be seen.

My premonition was warning me. Clearly this fog will not end.

"Yoo Joong—"

I saw something shining brightly in the fog. A beautifully sparkling object floating in the exact spot where the tiger and Ye Hyunwoo disappeared.

I immediately recognized what it was.

Yoo Joonghyuk, with blank eyes, was reaching out his hand toward the object.

"Yoo Joonghyuk! No!"

['Unidentified fragment' begins its storytelling.]

The world was colored with bright light.

「Kim Dokja’s Fragment.」

Damn it.

It seems that the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' knew what happened at the 'Washington Dome'.

And what happened to Yoo Joonghyuk, who came into contact with the 'Kim Dokja fragment' there?

Yoo Joonghyuk must not be allowed to have that. Then he will become a 'black beast' again.

I have to absorb that fragment before Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

However, Yoo Joonghyuk's hand touched the fragment first. The scenery of the world shimmered with a bright beam of light.

And the next moment, a message was heard.

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

The last time the 'Snowfield' was opened was when I met Kim Dokja.

Kim Dokja, who likes to leave footprints in the snow, drinks tea, and gives off a gentle but strangely cool feeling.

"Kim Dokja?"

But no matter where I looked, Kim Dokja was nowhere to be seen.

There is no snowy scenery that I remember. All I see is pitch black darkness.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

[The exclusive skill '□□' has been activated.]

[The exclusive skill '□□' resists the laws of the Recycling Center.]

Then a fact suddenly occurred to me. When I think about it, the first time I entered the 'Snowfield' was not when I met Kim Dokja.

To be exact, it was when Kim Cheolyang's 'next action' was described at Geumho Station.

This happened at a time when the ability to describe the empty spaces in a story was still available to me.

However, as I remember, this skill originally only activated in special situations.

「'□□' is a skill that only activates in times of 'survival' crisis.」

Does this mean that I am in a life and death situation?

So what sentence should I write?

Should I persuade Yoo Joonghyuk to throw away the 'Kim Dokja fragment'? Or, using additional probability—

[You cannot write sentences.]

I can't write?

Why—

"Kwaaaaaaaa!"

Someone's head exploded before my eyes. While I was stupidly looking at the bursting blood fountain, the surrounding scenery was slowly changing.

「Acrid smoke rising from everywhere. The thick bloody smell felt in the smoke of the battlefield.」

That wasn't the sentence I wrote. I was suddenly standing in the middle of a battlefield, swept away by a torrent of one-sided sentences.

I could smell my skin burning.

When I came to my senses, both of my arms were completely charred by fire.

What is this? Why am I suddenly like this?

When I raised my head with an eerie feeling, there were even more terrifying things floating in the sky.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are showing hostility towards you.]

I felt like I was losing my mind.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Vedas> laugh at your struggles.]

I was definitely at the 'Recycling Center'. And those guys could never enter the center.

But why?

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> are watching your final days.]

Why can I see those damn Constellations above my head right now?

Perhaps due to my mood, the sun shining in the air seemed to get bigger.

No, it wasn't an illusion.

The sun was getting closer and closer.

The blazing corona of the sun was visible. Beyond the corona, a distant great being was gazing at the Earth.

[The Constellation 'The Noon Sun' burns everything on earth!]

The solar wind blew. A scorching fire covered every living thing on the surface.

Right before my eyes, someone burned in real time and reached out to me.

"Save me—"

He died.

[You cannot change this 'story'.]

As the magma exploded, I held his hand.

[You have died.]

I died without even knowing why I had to die like that.

And when I opened my eyes again, I was running down a dark road.

[The Constellation 'Master of the Department of Killing' spits out quiet anger.]

I felt a huge figure writhing behind my back. I felt like my feet were sinking into the ground, and then hands came up from the dirt and grabbed my ankles.

Kyaaaaaaa!

「There was the smell of death everywhere. The smell of things that are already dead and will never return. All the souls who had lost their stories reached out and held on to the stories of the living.」

I instinctively realized where this was.

[Catch that guy.]

A cold voice came from behind me.

Without knowing why, I was holding a book I had never seen before in my hands.

「Department of Killing」

Department of killing?

At that moment, something came to mind.

「King Yeomra's Killing Book.」

The Book of Revelation, which records the 'lifespan' of everyone in the world.

I was now bouncing around with that Book of Revelation.

[This is the guy whose name was written three times in the death book. Be sure to catch him.]

Damn, I don't understand.

Anyway, I couldn't die here. I ran and ran again.

But soon a cliff appeared.

[You cannot write sentences.]

This time, I couldn't write a sentence.

[You cannot change this 'story'.]

With the feeling of a sharp dagger piercing the skin of my stomach, I fell a thousand miles down a cliff.

[You have died.]

When I opened my eyes again, I was sitting in a chair.

This time I wanted to do something again, but for some reason, I couldn't move my body at all. Someone had tied my body to a chair.

A chain made of 'Sulwha metal'.

I wondered who on earth would do such a terrible thing—

"Have you come to your senses?"

When I looked up, I saw Anna Croft's face.

I hurriedly tried to say something. But my mouth was covered.

"Tell me a secret."

Yes. I'll tell you. I'm going to tell you, so please let me solve this.

"Everything you’re hiding."

This was my first time seeing Anna Croft like that. Anna Croft's eyes filled with madness. She took a long nail out of her arms and held it close to my heart.

"Otherwise."

No, wait a minute.

"You will experience pain worse than death."

The first nail was driven right next to the heart. I felt like I was going to pass out at any moment, with a cold and heavy feeling penetrating my chest.

Anna Croft immediately took out a second nail.

"Say it."

And she stuck it in.

"Say it."

Then she took out the third nail,

"Say it."

She plugged it back in.

And.

[You cannot write sentences.]

[You cannot change this 'story'.]

…

[You have died.]

I felt like I was slowly going crazy. No person would be able to come to their senses if they suddenly fell down like this three times in a row.

Is death a joke?

How can humans die like this over and over again?

"You."

When I opened my eyes again with this thought in mind, I was in the middle of being slapped by someone.

One time, two times, three times, four times.

I felt like I was going to lose my mind from the powerful blows. No, I'm actually out of my mind.

Blood was already pouring from my lacquer tube.

"I don’t need trashy disciples."

Wait.

[You cannot write sentences.]

[You cannot change this 'story'.]

Please speak my mind.

[You have died.]

I died like that five, six, seven more times.

Something is wrong.

Why on earth am I experiencing this pain?

What on earth did I do wrong to end up in this situation?

When I opened my eyes again, I was in pitch black darkness.

But it wasn't the same darkness as before. A darkness much denser and more lonely than that. It was a darkness where the entire order of time seemed to be distorted.

In that darkness, I was taking a stab.

Once, twice, three times.

After the stabbing, the cutting was repeated.

Once, twice, three times.

A tedious task that involves repeating stabs and cuts in a rhythm.

I continued with it.

In the lonely darkness with no one around, I continued to stab and cut, assuming invisible virtual enemies. Ten thousand times, a hundred thousand times, a million times… The training continued as if to tear apart the darkness itself.

How many times did I stab and cut like that?

When I came to my senses, I forgot time, forgot my body, and eventually forgot myself.

「Perhaps that talent was not an innate talent.」

A feeling of mental impurities being drained away and soul clutter falling away.

「A talent that one person achieved by carving out his or her soul over a very long period of time.」

I can stab something without having to stab it, and I can cut it without having to cut it.

「Transcendence.」

A tremendous realization came over me.

I realized what that realization was.

This was the very sense of transcendence that Yoo Joonghyuk spoke of.

But as if something was wrong, a hot feeling rose from the back of my head. The heat then flashed my consciousness into pure white and led me into ecstasy.

[You cannot write sentences.]

Uh oh.

[You cannot change this 'story'.]

No, right?

[You have died.]

I'm so dumbfounded that I have nothing to say anymore.

And now I can clearly explain what situation I am in.

「I was currently experiencing the 'regressions' of 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.」

Black despair pressed down on his shoulders all the time.

The ending is death no matter what you do.

A hell that you can't escape from no matter what.

It was painful, but I went through that hell again and again.

I was able to get through it.

Because I knew that his eternity was not actually eternal.

There is no 'eternal hell'.

Someday this hell will end.

And at the end of hell, Yoo Joonghyuk reaches his conclusion.

So—

「There is an ending to this world.」

How much did I die, how much did I live, and how much did I run?

Even though I knew there was an end, I was just starting to feel like I couldn't go any further, when I felt the surroundings slowly becoming brighter. I had finally escaped from hell.

「There was a snowfield there.」

A pure white snowy landscape. I was looking at the end of the desolate world where thin snowflakes were falling for a while.

Then I saw something whitish moving in the distance. I unconsciously waved my hand and tried to approach, but stopped for a moment.

So far, only three people have been able to move in this 'snowfield'.

Me, Kim Dokja, and Han Sooyoung.

But what is that?

A small creature was crouching on the snowfield. As I approached, it immediately took on the appearance of a child. A child squatting on a white, burnt snowfield. The moment I met the child's dead eyes, I realized who the child was.

「There was a man who had to live a long story to save one person.」

Until now, I thought the 'Snowfield' was Kim Dokja's space.

「It is not the reader who lives between the invisible lines.」

Snowfield.

The unrecorded graves of a being.

「There was only one being who could 'survive' between those lines.」

A place where all stories are written, but perhaps nothing is written.

This snowfield,

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

From the beginning, it was one person's world.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 751 Episode 31 Yoo Joonghyuk (3)

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Little Yoo Joonghyuk slowly raised his head and looked at me.

I looked down at Yoo Joonghyuk.

The height of the gaze was unfamiliar. Whether as an adult or a child, Yoo Joonghyuk was always someone who looked down from above. But the current Yoo Joonghyuk was a little different.

An expression that makes you feel like he has truly become a child.

Did he lose his memory so much that he ended up in that state?

I wanted to ask. How long have you been here? I wonder how long he has endured this cold alone.

"This is the first time someone has been here."

The first to open his mouth was little Yoo Joonghyuk. Little Yoo Joonghyuk raised his head, and for a moment, there was something like a faint vitality in his eyes.

"You've finally come to get me, right?"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk raised his finger and pointed behind me. I don't know why, but white wings were fluttering behind my back.

I found out what kind of story it was.

[The 'unidentified fragment' reveals its identity.]

[The story fragment 'The Lost Wings of the Demon King' begins its storytelling.]

It seems that the 'unidentified fragment' that the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' had was these 'Wings of the Demon King of Salvation'.

"You can take me with you."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk said.

"Is it over now? What is heaven like?"

Heaven.

Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to really believe that such a thing exists.

"You're an angel. You know what heaven is like, right?"

I answered hesitantly.

"Heaven may not be as beautiful a place as you think."

"Then what kind of place is heaven?"

I don't even know what heaven is like. The heaven I knew was just one of countless worlds of Constellations.

"It is."

I thought of the Archangels from the <Star Stream>.

The Archangels are bored with Metatron's instructions, long for deviation while adhering to principles, and love their beloved incarnations.

"It's just a world where Angels herding sheep live."

"What is it?"

"If I could tell you in detail…"

I slowly bent down and sat down next to little Yoo Joonghyuk. Fragments of stories could be seen floating by little Yoo Joonghyuk's side. These were all memories of Yoo Joonghyuk.

「[Supreme King, leave this to me and see the end you want.]」

There was also an Archangel who sacrificed himself for Yoo Joonghyuk.

「[I'm sorry, but I can't let you become the Demon King.]」

There was also an Archangel who prevented Yoo Joonghyuk from becoming the Demon King.

「[I can see the sins you have accumulated. You will definitely become the great evil of this world.]」

There was also an Archangel who defined Yoo Joonghyuk as 'evil'.

「[Regressor, you will never go to heaven. Because the being who can dream of your heaven will never want you to go to heaven.]」

There was also an Archangel who was pessimistic about his life.

In just 41 regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk heard so many stories.

So this child already knows what heaven is like. He knew it, but now he has forgotten it.

"No. You don't have to tell me."

"What? Why?"

"I don't want to be disappointed. I'll definitely be disappointed if it's similar to where I used to live."

"Where did you live?"

"Huh."

The place where Yoo Joonghyuk lived.

When I think about it, I didn't know much about Yoo Joonghyuk's childhood.

This is because, like Kim Cheolyang and Bang Cheolsoo of Geumho Station, there were no remaining records about Yoo Joonghyuk's childhood.

The protagonist's childhood was not properly dealt with in 'TWSA' or 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

When I thought about that, I felt strange.

Although Han Sooyoung wrote so much text, she did not write properly about Yoo Joonghyuk's childhood.

"What was it like where you lived?"

Therefore, in a sense, Yoo Joonghyuk's childhood does not exist 'yet'.

"Where I lived…"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk frowned. The child said, rubbing his forehead several times with his small hand.

"I don’t remember."

I looked at the pieces of stories floating like dust around Yoo Joonghyuk.

[Story fragment 'Pro Gamer ■■' has stopped its storytelling.]

[Story fragment '■■■ Slave' has stopped its storytelling.]

Stories that have been around for too long without anyone reading them, some of them have been damaged beyond reading, and most of the content of others has disappeared. Or, it seemed like there was no content from the beginning. It's like a novel that only has a title but isn't written properly.

I opened my mouth.

"So do I."

"You don't remember where you lived too?"

"I remember, but only sporadically."

"Sparsely."

"Yeah, sparsely."

Whether it's the main character, supporting actor, or extra, perhaps it's the same for everyone. We all move closer to death, consuming our memories.

No one remembers their entire life in the process. As time goes by, we eventually become forgotten, even by ourselves.

So we talk.

I say it like I do now to remember things that were gone.

"The place where I live is a place with many stars. People explore the world with those stars. We all hunt monsters together and find new items."

"…"

"Some people may be praised by the stars and become great beings."

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes were shining as he listened to me. How much of the story remains inside this guy?

"A great being."

"Yes, a great being."

Yoo Joonghyuk shook his head at my words. Then he crouched down. Looking closely, I saw that Yoo Joonghyuk was covering his stomach.

"Will I become an Angel like you?"

"I am not an Angel."

"Then?"

I couldn't speak honestly to Yoo Joonghyuk, who looked up at me with pale eyes.

I am a Demon King.

So I said this.

"I am a writer."

"Writer?"

"A person who writes various stories. Funny stories, sad stories, difficult stories, even stories that should not be written. A person who writes various stories to survive."

"A person who writes stories."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk blinked slowly and smiled faintly. I wondered what he was thinking to himself.

This was my first time seeing little Yoo Joonghyuk smile, and I looked down at him in fascination for a moment.

"Then you are a god."

Instead of answering, I slowly stretched out my hand and tried to trace little Yoo Joonghyuk's stories.

The speed at which the story flowed was slow. As expected, he was dying.

"If I were God, I would be the most powerless god in the universe."

"What's the greatest story you've ever written?"

"That story."

I started talking.

That was the story I could tell best.

A story about a man whose novel he had spent his entire life loving becoming reality.

A story of monsters appearing, stars watching, saving someone, making friends, and running to see the epilogue of a world.

The child heard the story.

I thought as I watched the child listening to the story.

Kim Dokja was once saved by the story of Yoo Joonghyuk. He survived through his story and eventually survived.

So what about Yoo Joonghyuk?

When he was driven to the brink of his life, when he stood at the edge of a cliff where no one could save him. What saved him as a child?

I couldn't figure it out.

His world is just a vast snowy field.

A world that I cannot read or write about. A beginning that perhaps not only me but anyone else cannot know.

The origin of this entire universe.

「Every story we know began from this 41st Round.」

In 『Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World』, Yoo Joonghyuk was able to clear the scenarios by receiving information from Shin Yoosung from the 41st Round.

And again, in 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, Kim Dokja was able to see the end of the world based on the information of the 'Ways of Survival'.

The whole story started with Yoo Joonghyuk in front of me.

The whole story became possible only because he survived, fought, and ultimately failed.

"It's fun."

Young Yoo Joonghyuk smiled and slowly closed his eyes.

"But now I'm feeling sleepy."

Little Yoo Joonghyuk's shoulders shook as if he was getting chills. Meanwhile, the child was covering his stomach.

I carefully removed the child's hand and checked his condition.

Little Yoo Joonghyuk had a hole in his stomach.

It was the same as when Shin Yoosung was dying in the 24th Round. Yoo Joonghyuk-ah's stomach had the same scar as Shin Yoosung's, who had asked him to come to the graduation ceremony.

「Side effects of 'story imprinting'.」

If this wound is left alone, Yoo Joonghyuk will die. Even if he returns, his soul will be forever ruined.

Little Yoo Joonghyuk asked.

"Now are you going to take me to heaven?"

"I’m not taking you to heaven. I’m not an Angel."

All I can do is make him continue to live like that.

But I knew his ending.

A life that will ultimately fail and become food for other worldlines.

In order to keep the promise of the 0th Round, he went back and forth and ended up on a dead end—I knew that the end of this world would be a 'road without a road'.

That's why I couldn't recommend life to him. He was already extremely tired, so I couldn't tell him to live a life destined for failure.

"If I live a little longer."

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke once again.

"Can I hear the story you wrote again?"

I looked down at the child, not knowing what expression to make.

And I barely muttered.

"If you want."

Everything I've written is just a copy of one person's life.

That one person nodded his head.

White snow was falling on the Snowfield.

There was a world where no one had left any footprints.

A void that not even Han Sooyoung touched.

[The exclusive skill '□□' is extremely active.]

Only then did I realize why I had to come to this 41st Round.

[The amount of 'Disappearances' you have collected exceeds a certain level.]

The reason why I possessed Cheon Inho’s body.

[The 'Kim Dokja Fragments' you collected are starting to bloom.]

The reason I had to become the incarnation of the Demon King of Salvation, the reason I had to collect the fragments of Kim Dokja.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' recognizes your name.]

The reason why I had to come into this 'Recycling Center' and repaired my story.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Let’s promise."

And the reason Kim Dokja had to see this world.

"Never give up on life."

Just as the universe was born one day, Yoo Joonghyuk was born.

"As long as you don’t give up on life."

In return, he will have to walk for eternity again.

But unless he gives up, this time he won't be alone.

Probably not.

“I’ll keep writing for you.”

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was looking at me, slowly nodded.

As if answering his call, I took the first footprints to fill this Snowfield.

「This is a story about unreadable despair.」

Writing that sentence, I understood Han Sooyoung, who wrote about the destruction of the world for one person's life.

[The character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' gained a new realization.]

[The transcendence level of incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk' increases.]

Even if only one person lives in this world, even if everyone eventually forgets it and it is destined to crumble and disappear—I will not give up on this story until the end.

[The story 'Between Truth and Lies' is born!]

Finally, the Snowfield's sky opened.

[You have created a total of four stories.]

[All the stories you have accumulated are 'legendary level' or higher.]

[The Management Bureau analyzes your status.]

[The <Star Stream> is reevaluating your status.]

[Your sponsor is currently absent.]

[Your sponsor has granted you all authority.]

.

.

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[You can now act as a Constellation.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 752 Episode 31 Yoo Joonghyuk (4)

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After 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' left, a message was released.

[Due to the scenario's direct change, the start date of the 'Zodiac Ball' is adjusted.]

[The 'Zodiac Ball' will begin in 12 hours.]

[Currently, 71% of the prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

[To participate in the 'Zodiac Ball' you must secure an additional 9%.]

In the process of fighting the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes', our approval rating actually rose despite the fact that a huge number of prisoners died.

"I never thought there would be an incarnation that could stand against the <Zodiac>…"

Someone had expectations of us.

"Zone 13 is in the spotlight because of you guys."

Someone criticized us.

"I think it would be a good idea to leave Zone 13 at this point."

Some people advised us to give up on Zone 13.

He was the crane owner in 「The Fox and the Crane」.

"I would welcome any of the zodiac signs. I have never seen such an outstanding incarnation at Zone 13 of the 'Recycling Center'."

According to the system, the story of exterminating the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was widely known throughout Star Stream through the center director.

[Your new tale spreads widely throughout the <Star Stream>.]

[Some Constellations were greatly impressed by your story.]

[18,000 coins were donated through the 'Recycling Center'.]

As evidence, messages were still being delivered in real time.

[A few Nebulae want you to join them.]

[The Nebula <Hongik> invites you.]

[The Nebula <Tamra> invites you.]

[The Nebula <Samyo> invites you.]

…

The small and medium-sized Nebulae that were being pushed out by the Giant Nebulae sent me messages to do business with me.

Among them, there were even <Hongik> and <Tamna>, the Nebulae of the Korean Peninsula.

I was curious because it was Nebulae that did not appear properly in the main story, but I had no intention of choosing them here.

This was because we were still trapped in the 'Recycling Center' and the scenario related to the <Zodiac> was still in progress.

[The faction 'Monkey God' invites you to the 'Zodiac Ball'.]

[The faction 'Dragon God' invites you to the 'Zodiac Ball'.]

Some factions of the Zodiac also sent invitations to me, as if word had spread that I had declined the tiger's invitation.

"I have no intention of entering <Zodiac>.»

But I didn't come this far just to join that animal union.

"I will attend the 'Zodiac Ball' without anyone’s sponsorship."

I needed the support of eighty percent of the prisoners.

And that was the reason why I was now meeting the crane owner.

"Many prisoners, including me, are already supporting you."

The crane owner, who already knew my situation, sighed lightly and continued.

"But there has never been a representative whose approval rating exceeded 80% in Zone 13."

"Just because it’s never happened doesn’t mean it’s impossible."

"Now the only ones left are the bears and some other beastmen. But it will be difficult to gain their support."

The prisoners nearby are all supporting me. The only exceptions were the bears that followed the Tiger, and their subordinate forces.

But no matter what I did, I could not persuade them.

"Because they don’t have any stories left that you can repair."

The prisoners who we were able to persuade all had 'forgotten stories'.

We revived those stories through 「Staging」 and spread them through the <Star Stream>.

The prisoners supported us in return. But in the case of the bear beastmen, that was impossible.

"Is there no way?"

"Honestly, there is none. Wouldn’t it be great if you were a Constellation like the 'Master of Fables'? Isn’t it impossible to give individual stories to all of them?"

"If it's the owner of fables, you're probably referring to the Constellation that wrote 'Aesop's Fables'."

"That’s right. We don’t have enough time."

"They are not people who can listen by simply threatening them with force. In particular, the 'Bear That Will Spare You If You Pretend To Be Dead' is a Constellation with strong pride."

He looked down at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was sleeping soundly on the bed, and added:

"Perhaps there is a 'story' that can sweep them all away at once. Can you help me with this?"

I helped the crane owner wake Yoo Joonghyuk up from his sleep and fed him some soup. It was a special soup with the story of 「The Fox and the Crane」.

He's the kind of guy who never eats food made by someone else, so I was glad he was unconscious right now.

After feeding him some soup, Yoo Joonghyuk's pale complexion became a little more lively.

The crane owner sighed lightly and said.

"Anyway, this guy got smaller again, but I was really scared when he cut down the

"I’m glad he's smaller."

"Anyway, take care of him. I’ll come again."

With those last words, the crane owner left the room.

I took a few bites of the soup the owner left behind and looked at Yoo Joonghyuk who was sleeping for a moment.

After that incident three days ago, Yoo Joonghyuk had been sleeping ever since.

Perhaps due to the side effects of [Story Engraving], Yoo Joonghyuk became little Yoo Joonghyuk again.

He wasn't as small as the little Yoo Joonghyuk I saw in the snowfield, but he would probably be like this for a while anyway.

The 41st Round was the last Round for Yoo Joonghyuk.

He transmitted his experience to his past self through Shin Yoosung and exited the record of 'Ways of Survival'.

I repeat, no one knows what happened to that guy after he left.

Has he stopped regressing in some way, or has he disappeared forever from his records in some way I don't know?

If he had disappeared from his records, would he have finally achieved his wish?

"Don’t worry too much."

I muttered as I covered the sleeping little boy, Yoo Joonghyuk, with a blanket.

"Because this Round won’t be ruined so easily."

The person who starts a story has a responsibility not to give up on it.

I made a promise to Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear' responds to your oath.]

This story may not be 『Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World』 or 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, but it will definitely have the right ending.

Now it was time to go see the end of this Round for that conclusion.

---

An hour later, I gathered together the Bear Beastmen and the Beastmen who had not expressed support.

The guys seemed taken aback or confused by my sudden call.

Some even reacted with hostility .

[Why did you call us?]

Their representative was the Constellation that invaded this place—'Bear That Will Spare You If You Pretend To Be Dead'.

[If you're calling us to support you, you'd better give up.]

"Why?"

[Because we have no intention of supporting you.]

"So why?"

[There is no reason to explain that.]

"Of course you will.

I squatted down in my seat and let out a deep sigh. Then I looked up at the guys.

"But you… is it okay for you to continue like that?"

No matter what I say, they won't be persuaded by me.

The reason is obvious.

Because they don't need my help.

What should we do for those who have lost their stories?

Maybe I've been thinking about this problem for quite some time.

Some extras found their own stories on their own. Like Bang Cheolsoo from Geumho Station. Like the mother and daughter. Like the crane owner.

But not everyone could do it like they did.

Some people find their own stories, but others live and die without even knowing what their stories are.

For example, like the bears in front of me right now.

"Honestly, it doesn’t really matter whether you support me or not. I can rise to the top somehow."

[Then why did you call us?]

"To give you one last chance."

I know that not everyone can purely support me.

Kim Dokja also knew that.

No matter what he did, some Constellations hated Kim Dokja's story.

Kim Dokja pioneered his life by fighting against that gaze, and eventually it also became his story.

But it wasn't easy for me to accept it.

Maybe it's because I'm a 'writer'.

I wanted to write a perfect story that Kim Dokja had never read and that he didn't know about.

[The story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear' responds to your emotions.]

But it was impossible.

I finally realized it as I went through Geumho Station, Chungmuro, the Theater Dungeon, Gwanghwamun, Washington Dome, and the Recycling Center.

There is no story that all the Constellations in the world love.

Even more so if it is the story of the 'Forgotten Round'.

So I accepted.

It's okay even if not all prisoners support me. It's safe to say that they hate the stories I'm going to write.

"This is truly your last chance. Your chance to choose me by yourself."

But I just write stories.

[What does that mean?]

"I don’t think there’s any reason to explain what it means."

[The Constellation 'Bear That Spares One's Life if One Pretends To Be Dead' is outraged!]

Even a Constellation that has lost all of its status still has pride.

[How dare a mere incarnation carry beastmen on its back—!]

But he misjudged.

"It’s not just an incarnation."

I grinned and looked at him.

Until a few days ago, its power was threatening. I thought that he would be a difficult enemy to defeat if I did not use 『Staging』.

However.

"Has your eyesight deteriorated and you’ve forgotten how to read stories?"

His status no longer seemed great to me.

I slowly stood up.

[You are currently acting as the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

[The status of the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' rests fully upon you.]

As my entire body radiated the majestic energy of stories, bright light began to flow from my incarnation body.

Some of the prisoners who noticed it were frightened and bowed their heads.

"Stand, the Constellation…!"

Even the 'Bear That Spares One's Life if One Pretends To Be Dead' was looking at me with shocked eyes.

As I lightly placed my hand on the guy's shoulder, his knees slowly began to buckle.

The guy shouted as if he was struggling.

[No matter what you do, it’s useless. We will never do your favor—]

"Oh, did that sound like a request?"

A way to persuade those who have lost their stories, lost their memories, and ultimately lost the ability to read.

"I'll tell you again. You only have one choice."

The crane owner said. Those who have lost their own stories are just being swept away by other 'stories' like a torrent.

So the only way to persuade them is through 'stories'.

[The story begins 'Incite'.]

So, the method I would choose was decided.

[Support me.]

It becomes the story of 'I will sweep them all away'.

[It must be scary to jump into the scenarios again. I know. That's why I'm saying it.]

I saw the confused beastmen looking up at me one by one. A faint trace of emotion passed through their dead eyes.

[At least as long as you support me, I will be your 'story'. I will fight on your behalf and become a laughingstock for the Constellations on your behalf.]

My persuasion was not persuasion.

My words will not be heard in their ears. They are simply overwhelmed by my story and crushed by the status of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

So their choice now is,

[Just support me. Then at least you will be able to see the end of this world through me.]

In fact, it wasn't a choice.

[Your approval rating begins to rise.]

[Your approval rating has reached a certain level.]

[Currently, 83% of prisoners in Zone 13 support you.]

It was an easy and clear ending.

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is scolding you for not doing this sooner.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' says that sometimes a decision like that of an 'Adventurer Who Laid An Egg' is needed.]

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' looks at you sadly.]

And as always, clear cider,

[The Constellation 'Bear That Spares One's Life if One Pretends To Be Dead' rejects your instigation.]

[The Constellation 'Bear That Spares One's Life if One Pretends To Be Dead' loses his story and chooses to disappear.]

The aftertaste was bitter.

[You have obtained permission to attend the 'Zodiac Ball'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 753 Episode 31 Yoo Joonghyuk (5)

---

"Dokja-ssi! I heard your approval rating exceeded 80%?"

Kyung Sein and the others were unaware of the details of my negotiations with the 'Bear Beastmen' as they were each traveling throughout Zone 13 to gain additional support.

"Wow, how on earth did you convince them?"

"I don’t know if I should call that persuasion."

Not all bears were persuaded.

The leader 'Bear Who Will Spare One’s Life if One pretends to be Dead' rejected my instigation and disappeared.

The bear who took over his story and became the leader of the new bears, said this.

"The leader fulfilled his mission. He felt that this was his ■■."

■■.

Is there an end to the road even for those who have lost their dreams?

"Don’t feel guilty. The boss just entrusted us to you. All you have to do is keep your promise."

The companions who heard my story had solemn expressions.

"I don’t know what to say. After all, you can’t force the same dream on everyone."

The bears were an enemy he had fought just a few days ago, but no hostility could be found in Kyung Sein's tone anymore.

Friend or enemy, in the end, everyone is just a part of this huge story. That was the lesson we learned while building the story here.

"Kim Dokja, when are you going to leave?"

In response to Killer King's question, I checked the 'System Message' floating in the air.

[You can attend the 'Zodiac Ball'.]

[Choose the colleagues you want to attend the ball with by midnight tonight.]

[The eighth scenario automatically ends as soon as you attend the 'Zodiac Ball'.]

"By midnight tonight."

Midnight tonight.

Finally, we’ll meet the Constellations of the Chinese zodiac.

Kyung Sein asked with a stern expression, maybe nervous about going to a new scenario area.

"Yoo Joonghyuk hasn’t woken up yet. Will it be okay?"

"It’s okay. If he doesn't wake up, I’ll at least slap his butt to wake him up. 'like Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'."

We looked at each other and laughed.

"But what exactly is the 'Zodiac Ball'?"

"It’s an event that has never been mentioned in the Book of Revelation."

As Cha Yerin said, the 'Zodiac Ball' was definitely an event that did not appear in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

I can only guess that it will have a similar feel to the 'Constellation's Banquet'.

"It would be good to know the information in advance."

"How?"

I pointed to a corner of the inn with my chin. There was a little rat prisoner tied up tightly.

[The Constellation, 'Nail-Eating Rat' is trembling and looking at you.]

---

It was six months ago that Kim Soogyeom first became aware of the phenomenon of possession.

'It's an unfamiliar ceiling.'

The moment he realized that fact, Kim Soogyeom was thrilled.

Having acquired a repertoire of 'possessing people' through comics, novels, and animations, he was surprised by the appearance of an unfamiliar ceiling, but was not embarrassed.

'I just waited for this moment.'

To him, who was a repeat student—to be exact, he had retaken the CSAT but failed the CSAT and was about to take the third attempt—this possession felt like a kind of salvation.

The problem was the object of his possession.

[Squeak.]

Of all the objects, why did I possess this one?

[Squeak.]

The only comforting thing was that this 'squeak' was not "squeak" but [squeak].

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' squeaks.]

The moment he read the word Constellation floating in the air, Soogyeom Kim realized what kind of world he had arrived in.

[Are you here, Sugyeom?]

[Squeak… ah?]

What's even more surprising is that his friends arrived first.

[I thought you would come too.]

There are two friends who possessed someone together with Kim Soogyeom.

Their modifiers were as follows:

'Pig in a Brick House'.

And 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'.

—Kyung Sein: No, you were originally friends with the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes'?

Kim Soogyeom was excited.

I am not alone!

I'm not alone in this damn world!

While possessing Constellations, they decided to call each other by their Constellation names.

'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is a tiger.

'Pig in a Brick House' is a pig.

And Kim Soogyeom is a rat.

He didn't like the name, but he couldn't help it. Because it was the tiger who decided that.

[But why did I possess someone in this novel?]

The rat answered the tiger's question.

[It’s because of you. You liked this novel.]

[The rat said you read it too.]

[I didn't like it that much.]

However, no matter how hard they think about it, the phenomenon of possession itself does not change.

[What scenario are you all in now?]

[I am in the 69th. The rat is number 63.]

[I am in the 71st. I've come the furthest, but honestly, looking at the difficulty level of the scenario, I think it would be impossible for us to get to the final scenario on our own.]

[It was like that in the original.]

[Ah, why did we have to possess an animal Constellation? It would have been better if it was someone like Sun Wukong or Hades.]

[What do we do now?]

[We need to find Kim Dokja.]

But soon they realized.

[I think we are ■ here.]

There is no 'Kim Dokja' in this world.

But they were not frustrated.

What would they be without Kim Dokja? All they have to do is make Kim Dokja.

[What do you think? Who should I sponsor?]

[How is he over there?]

[Isn’t he originally a villain?]

[He's a villain, though. …Uh? Well, isn’t there something strange about that?]

[Huh? Uh huh?]

[Squeak!]

The moment the first scenario ended and they saw Cheon Inho alive at Geumho Station, the three friends realized something.

[I decided on you.]

—Lee Dansu: Oh, by any chance, in 'Sponsor Selection' at that time…!

From then on, Kim Soogyeom and his colleagues began sponsoring.

Unfortunately, all three failed to become Cheon Inho's Constellation, but it was not something they wanted as they were Historical-grade Constellations anyway.

In the meantime, they learned that there was another Constellation in the same situation.

[The Constellation 'Primordial Cow' shrugs.]

They also learned that there are Constellations plotting evil plans.

—Cha Yerin: The Misreading Association.

The two forces immediately antagonized.

That's right, one side was the side that wanted to support the main character and see the ending, and the other side was the side that wanted to become the main character of this world by exterminating the main character and the other side.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' roars!]

[The Constellation 'Snake cutting its tail' screams!]

[The Constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' builds a brick house.]

[The Constellation 'Rat Bringing Plague' begins to eat the bricks.]

After fighting every time they encountered each other, the Constellations eventually decided to get together and negotiate.

Of course, there was no way the negotiations could work properly.

[Snake, I warn you. Don't interfere with the story. Unless you really want to get lost.]

[How pathetic. Are you really going to lose control of the story to people like that? We are Constellations.]

[Birds who do illegal downloading■ keep their mouths open—]

[So, did you guys buy them all?]

[Of course we…]

[Swear to the <Star Stream>. You've never read a novel on an illegal site?]

—Killer King: So who didn't take the oath?

They continued to fight and antagonize and grab each other like that for several months.

A lot has changed in them in those few months. They came to talk like a Constellation, think like a Constellation, and act like a Constellation.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' cheers for Cheon Inho.]

If you think about it, that wasn't such a strange change.

[The Constellation 'Primordial Cow' is amazed by Jung Heewon's majesty.]

Maybe they lived similarly even before becoming a Constellation.

[The Constellation 'Pig Living a Brick House' feels frustrated with Yoo Joonghyuk.]

They were happy, sad or angry while watching the scenarios of the incarnations, and sometimes even moved.

And at some point they forgot the scenario they had to clear.

Some friends even helped the main character by exceeding the probability allowed to them.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' was one of them.

In particular, after sponsoring the 'core of the devil species' as the material for 'Unbreakable Faith', the condition of the 'Tiger' began to deteriorate noticeably.

[Tiger, are you okay?]

[Hmm? Rat, what's going on?]

[I'm asking this because your complexion is pale.]

One week, two weeks, one month.

Time continued to pass.

Because he did not want to be left out among friends who laughed or cried, Kim Soogyeom occasionally wrote indirect messages. But every time he wrote a message, he got the feeling that something was going wrong.

[The story 'The Rat Who Desires an Incarnation' urges you to find a new incarnation.]

[The story 'Back Alley Thief Rat' orders you to lick the story that fell on the floor.]

[The story 'Gluttonous Rat' wants to devour new stories.]

When did stories start speaking to them?

Or maybe they were talking to them from the beginning and they didn't know?

Was supporting the main characters and devouring their stories all a command of the stories? Then,

[The story 'Nail-Eating Rat' is looking at you.]

Could it be that they are now being consumed by 'stories'?

Kim Soogyeom, terrified, threw away his story and ran away. Wherever he went, stories followed him, but fortunately he was a 'Rat' who was good at running away. Among the zodiac animals, the rat was the fastest.

But unfortunately his friends were not 'rats'.

---

Killer King, who had listened to the rat's story to the end, shook his head and said.

"So that’s what happened."

It was only after listening to the story that I could understand why the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' had changed so much.

Most of the animal-type Constellations above, as well as the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes', are probably in the same state.

They are no longer 'readers'.

[I, I came to tell you this. Never climb up. The Constellations of the 'Zodiac Ball' are all crazy. And the guys who were the Five Dogs Association—]

The moment he said that, the rat's mouth suddenly froze.

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' screams!]

Along with the rat's terrible scream, terrible sparks began to blow into the rat's incarnation body.

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' takes a huge hit and leaves 'Zone 13'.]

It happened so quickly that I had no time to do anything.

I looked down at the small claw left where the rat had been.

Killer King asked.

"Just now…"

“It’s hard to say that he simply lost to the story."

No matter how much he has lost his 'status', he was still a 'Historical-grade Constellation'. If he had disappeared due to being dominated by a story like the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes', some other symptom would have appeared.

I said, looking up at the night sky that had already become dark.

"There's someone..."

Clearly, this is the work of a guy who exists in a higher-level scenario. It is also a being that can exorcise the 'Nail-Eating Rat', a powerful Constellation, with a single blow.

"In the 'Zodiac', there is a being equivalent to a 'Narrative-grade Constellation'."

Normally, it would have been a time when Kyung Sein or Dansu ahjussi would have been scared and uttered a word. But this time no one said anything. Because they already knew that there was a powerful enemy up there.

"Get ready to go up quickly."

---

Exactly one hour later, we finished getting ready and gathered in the central clearing of『The Fox and the Crane』.

A small cargo was rising in the center of the clearing. Perhaps the crane owner had prepared it in advance.

We sat naturally around the bonfire.

"Zone 13 is also the last."

Everyone's eyes are deep in their own thoughts. This time, Kyung Sein was the first to open her mouth.

"Dokja-ssi, I have a question."

"Yes. Please tell me."

"By any chance… have you become a Constellation?"

I answered with a bitter smile.

"It’s just a replacement."

"Replacement? Is something like that possible?"

I briefly explained my situation.

"Then you will be able to act as a Constellation for the time being."

"I guess so."

"Are you okay, Dokja-ssi? I wonder if the stories are speaking to you like the Constellations before…"

"Oh, me."

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' is grumbling at you.]

"Sometimes there are some who start fights, but it's okay. It's just similar to what Kim Dokja experienced."

After hesitating for a moment, Kyung Sein added.

"It somehow flows in a similar way to the Book of Revelation. It seems that Kim Dokja became qualified as a Constellation around this time in the Book of Revelation."

It was like that. I think it was definitely around that time.

"If Dokja-ssi is Kim Dokja, we all have our own roles, right? For me, I guess it's Lee Hyunsung. And Dansu ahjussi is… Han Myungoh?"

"No, Sein-ssi."

"Of course Yerin-ssi is Jung Heewon, and…"

Kyung Sein hesitated for a moment.

She probably was reminded of Ye Hyunwoo.

Killer King intervened with good timing.

"Of course I am Yoo Joonghyuk."

"Yes. I think the second apostle is Kim Namwoon."

"You."

The companions burst into light laughter.

Dansu ahjussi opened his mouth as if organizing things.

"We are just who we are. I don't think there's any need to compare ourselves to others. I'm definitely not saying this because I was compared to Han Myungoh."

That was right.

We cannot be <Kim Dokja Company>.

The man named Lee Dansu, who was touching his knee in embarrassment, added:

"But honestly, I don’t think we’re inferior to <Kim Dokja Company> at this level."

That was also correct.

Above all, everyone in the party has learned [Way of the Wind]. Even if we look at us one by one, our growth rate was not bad.

Not only was Kyung Sein capable of tanking as powerfully as Lee Hyunsung of the same period, but he also had much more agility than him.

Dansu ahjussi not only has the 'Sneaky Schemer' as his Constellation, but also has 'Immortal King' as his characteristic.

There was no need to mention the talented Cha Yerin, who was the first to master [Way of the Wind].

And Killer King.

"Kim Dokja, you’re looking at me with unpleasant eyes."

Above all, we have Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st Round. In terms of potential alone, our protagonist has more formidable fighting power than any other Round.

"It’s not like I don’t have friends like Jihye-ssi, Hyunsung-ssi, Heewon-ssi, and Yoosoung-ssi… Isn’t this Round quite interesting?"

I forgot about them for a while.

If we look at it closely, we can confidently say that the 41st Round's power was stronger than any other round, as there were key characters such as Lee Jihye, Lee Hyunsung, and Kim Namwoon.

Now that I think about it, where have other characters like Jung Heewon and Shin Yoosung gone? Ji Eunyu and Anna Croft are nowhere to be seen either.

Looking at the situation, it seems like they fell in an area other than Zone 13...

If I participate in the 'Zodiac Ball', I might meet them.

[The story 'Between Truth and Lies' is looking at you.]

A mumbling story was talking to me. It felt like Yoo Joonghyuk had woken up.

It was a signal to me that it was time to leave.

Killer King asked since he felt the energy of the story.

"Is that a newly acquired story?"

"Yes."

Eyes that somehow seem envious or admiring.

Killer King looked up at the story that was floating above my head for a long time after that. Then he pressed his lips several times and slowly opened his mouth.

"I am Cha Sungwoo."

Cha Sungwoo.

The group turned to each other at the soft voice.

The name of the person Killer King possessed was Kang Ilhoon, but Killer King said his name was 'Cha Sungwoo'.

"My name is Noh Kyunghwan. I'm sure everyone knows this."

The person who opened his mouth next was Dansoo ahjussi. I knew the man's real name well, but the weight of that name sounded different.

While the embers of the bonfire were lightly bouncing, there was someone who took over the baton.

"I'm Sung Minwoo."

Judge Heewon— alsdn0905.

The person who had been called 'Kyung Sein' until now smiled as if she were embarrassed.

"This is the first time I say my name."

As she scratched her cheek shyly, Literature Girl 64—Cha Yerin, who was next to her—said.

"I'm Cha Yerin."

Cha Sungwoo, Noh Kyunghwan, Sung Minwoo, and Cha Yerin.

Geumho Station, Chungmuro Station, Gwanghwamun, the names of the people who have been through those difficult scenarios together.

Cha Yerin said to me who hesitated.

"You don't have to tell us your name. We just wanted to tell you."

The moment I heard those words, I realized something.

「They know.」

Since when? I don't know anything like that.

But they knew who I was. Still, so far they haven't asked a single question. Who I am and where I come from. What am I doing with them?

There is only one name allowed in this world: my name.

"I."

But can that name provide a sufficient explanation about me to the people in front of me?

I looked down at my hands. The warmth of the bonfire passed through my fingertips as I wrote the sentence.

All the stories in this world are fiction that exists for just one person.

Nevertheless, the warmth of this moment was never a lie.

I opened my mouth.

"My name is."

As time passes, the bonfire we gathered around will turn to ashes.

This warmth, this scenery, the fact that we shared this story, everything will be forgotten forever.

It's okay though.

"It's Lee Hakhyun."

At least at this moment, we are reading this story together.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 754 Episode 32 Monkey King (1)

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「When I write a story, I often get confused. Am I writing the story, or is the story using me to reveal itself? Anna, have you ever thought about that?」

—Asuka Ren

---

It was the first time I revealed my name to my companions. The reason I've been hesitating so far is because I didn't want to cause any unnecessary discomfort.

In fact, it was Han Sooyoung who wrote Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, but it was I who wrote Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint in the worldline in which I lived.

And the readers in front of me are people from the same world line as me.

When they hear my name, they can't help but be embarrassed.

"Wait a minute, that name."

As expected, Kyung Sein reacted first.

Dansu ahjussi, who was next to Kyung Sein, also looked surprised as if he had realized something.

Actually, I thought they might know, but everyone turned out to be not as perceptive than I expected...

"What Korean characters form your name?"

I felt a little embarrassed by the ahjussi's unexpected question.

"This is mine: Hak鶴(crane) Hyun翾((lightly) flying)."

I said, omitting (lightly) in front of Hyun.

Dansu ahjussi shook his head in admiration.

"It's a very noble name. I can sense that the person who named you put a lot of thought into it."

"Wow, Ahjussi. Can you even read my name?"

"I did some studying on the meaning of names when I came up with Jiyoon's name. Lee Hakhyun. It's a good name."

A good name?

No, wait, this isn't important… Did he not notice anything at all?

Didn't you just say my name?

"Excuse me…"

Kyung Sein responded by waving her hand as if she knew what I was going to say.

"Ah, don't worry. I'll call you 'Kim Dokja' from now on."

"No, that's…"

"If we call Hakhyun-ssi 'Kim Dokja', the name of 'Kim Dokja' will become famous! A story will be created! There will be a higher chance that 'Kim Dokja', including the Demon King of Salvation, will notice us!"

"Yes, that's true…"

"Don't worry, I will definitely protect you!"

I looked at Kyung Sein blankly and let out a light sigh.

I thought it might have gone well.

I don't know if she's pretending not to know, or if she really doesn't know.

When I thought about it, it wasn't strange that she didn't know my name. Ordinary readers remember the works they read, but they do not remember the name of the author who wrote the work.

At that time, Killer King across from me spoke.

"I don’t know about naming, but it’s a very cool name."

I looked at the faces of my companions one by one and found the only one whose complexion had changed.

An unusually pale face.

There was a fact that suddenly occurred to me as I looked at Cha Yerin avoiding my eyes.

Oh, come to think of it, Yerin knows.

[It is time to enter the 'Zodiac Ball'.]

[Representative of Zone 13, please designate companion signs to 'companions' who will enter together.]

Is it finally time?

There were a total of six people in the group, including Yoo Joonghyuk and me.

I left a 'companion designation mark' on the back of each member’s hand.

The mark looked exactly like someone's face, but no matter how I looked at it, it didn't look like that of an animal.

This… Doesn't his face look similar to mine?

The next moment, the sky split open and an Orbital Elevator descended toward the ground. Elevator doors open with a light cloud of dust.

But for some reason, the inside of the elevator was a little narrow.

[Two people can board the Orbital Elevator at a time.]

[Please board with one companion.]

Wait for a sec. What about the rest?

[Additional Orbital Elevators will arrive soon.]

Ah, is this how multiple units arrive? It would have been more convenient if we all went together, but I don't know why we formed pairs.

Could this be related to the following scenario? Well, if it weren't for that, there's no reason to put this kind of restriction on it.

I looked back at my companions.

It doesn't matter who I take, but it would probably be better for me to take the most dangerous one.

Just as I was about to call out to Yoo Joonghyuk, a boy appeared from afar near thedoors.

Cha Sungwoo pushed someone towards me.

"Take this one away first."

---

A long time ago, I participated in an event called 'Conversation with Readers'. It was an event held at a small local bookstore.

The event was structured in a way that five or six writers, including myself, and about thirty readers had a conversation together.

Of course, none of the readers who participated that day had read my novel.

It was natural. At that time, I was a kid who had just debuted in the literary world. Even though we were all authors, I was an unknown author who had not published a single book, and the other authors were new artists who were attracting attention in the literary world.

Readers everywhere raise their hands and ask questions, and writers answer them.

There, I was neither a writer nor a reader, but simply a member of the audience watching their stories.

I think I had that thought at first glance as I watched the Q&A going on.

Will I be able to be asked that question someday?

Would I be able to meet someone who is curious about my story with such deep eyes?

"I."

Below the slowly ascending Orbital Elevator, the scenery of Zone 13 was receding.

"Well, I don’t know what to say."

I saw Cha Yerin standing side by side inside the window. Maybe it was because the elevator was so narrow, but the air inside made me feel suffocated.

It occurred to me later that the writers who were being asked questions at that time were not all that happy.

Does Cha Yerin resent me for hiding my identity as a writer?

But from my perspective, it was an inevitable choice. Because at that time, I still couldn’t trust Cha Yerin.

Even so, I didn't reveal my identity too late. Shouldn't I have given at least a small hint? Otherwise—

"Sorry."

Unexpectedly, it was Cha Yerin who apologized first.

I threw up my hands, somewhat embarrassed.

"My brother created an uncomfortable situation for no reason."

"No. I should have told you a long time ago—"

"Because my brother knows everything."

It wasn't difficult to take into account what it meant to know.

Perhaps Killer King—Cha Sungwoo knew that I was a writer and that his younger sister liked novels by an author named Lee Hakhyun.

That's probably why he pushed his sister into the Orbital Elevator.

"A lot of time has already passed."

Cha Yerin's voice was deep, as if she was reflecting on the past years.

"It went by so quickly. It was as if it was written 'and several months passed'."

It was indeed a metaphor worthy of Literature Girl 64.

I remembered the day I first met Cha Yerin. That day, we were in the 'Edge of Darkness' and fighting against the Misreading Association.

It was a time when enemies and allies were still unclear.

"It’s somehow fascinating."

I could see the beasts moving away under the Orbital Elevator. The crane owner who was supposed to support us was waving his hand. The leader of the Bear Beastmen also stood out.

In a world where everything becomes a story, even this moment will one day become a story.

We looked down at our colleagues who shared the story. There were people there waiting for the Orbital Elevator. Cha Sungwoo, Noh Kyunghwan, Sung Minwoo, and Yoo Joonghyuk.

Cha Yerin, who was looking down at the scenery together, added.

"They can become colleagues just by liking the same story."

"Luckily, they’re all good people."

"Author."

"Yes."

"I’ll only call you that until the Orbital Elevator is up."

"I understand. Is it okay if I call you reader?"

Cha Yerin quietly lowered her head and looked down at her own toes. Then, her expression hardened and she asked.

"We are in a bad situation. Is this the author’s intention?"

"No."

With the authority of a Constellation, I searched for the stars that watch over us. Fortunately, there were no prying eyes on the conversation inside the Orbital Elevator.

Well, it meant that here you can talk as much as you want without worrying about filtering.

"Can I tell you a little about my situation?"

Cha Yerin briefly nodded her head and I started talking.

The day before I possessed a character, I received a strange note from Representative Kim Dokja.

'Participating in Kim Dokja’s banquet and meeting Representative Kim Dokja'.

When I came to my senses, I was suddenly possessing a character in this world.

"It’s very similar to what happened to Kim Dokja. It’s almost like someone parodied it."

It's a parody.

I hadn't even thought of that.

"What does it feel like to possess a character in a story you wrote yourself?"

"I should have written a more peaceful story. I should have made the main character die less."

We looked at each other and smiled.

"Can we change the ending?"

"I will change it."

Before we knew it, the scenery of Zone 13 was no longer visible. As the Orbital Elevator entered the floor, the view outside was pitch black.

"The ending of the 41st Round has been decided."

"The story of the 41st Round has not been read properly yet."

"You can fix it because you’ve never worked on it."

"Yes. I think so."

"It won’t be easy."

"I guess so. But there’s Yerin-ssi, Sungwoo-ssi, and other colleagues."

The scenarios that will come in the future are different from the initial scenarios where we were just grappling with the incarnations.

"It’s worth a try."

What is waiting for us above now are at least 'Historical-grade Constellations'.

We will compete with them in scenarios.

"Please tell me you can write well."

I looked at Cha Yerin in the dark.

Even though she appeared calm from beginning to end, she must be afraid. If I remember her in real life, she would be a girl in her late teens at most.

"I will do my best."

"Please tell me one more time."

"I will do my best. There are people who read my boring debut work to the end."

"It wasn’t boring."

Even in the dark, I felt like I could see her straight face.

"The Origin of Memory is my favorite novel."

The Origin of Memory.

When I heard the title of my debut work, I felt embarrassed. It felt like I was being dragged back to 'Conversation with Readers' after a few years.

"Why? Why do you like that novel?"

Even on the entire Korean Peninsula, there would be less than fifty people who have read that novel. And most of them probably even don’t even remember that title.

In a sense, the Cha Yerin in front of me right now was the only reader who remembered the novel written by the author 'Lee Hakhyun'.

Cha Yerin said.

"Kim Dokja loves Ways of Survival."

"Yes."

"And I love The Origin of Memory."

I couldn't answer anything.

Cha Yerin continued speaking as if she understood my silence.

"『The Origin of Memory』. It's a story about a man searching for his origins."

For the first time in a while, I remembered the contents of that novel.

The main character of 『The Origin of Memory』 has no name. Neither does he have parents. So he created his own past. He designed all the stories related to himself, including his birth, his parents, and his family, and said that it was him.

But no one could say that the story was false. Because no one knows his past.

Even he himself.

"I was jealous."

I thought about what kind of person Cha Yerin wa. She is a child who lost her parents at birth and was left in an orphanage.

The only people who remember her story are herself and her brother.

"I like the last scene. It's the part where the main character faces his younger self."

In the final scene of『The Origin of Memory』, the protagonist faces his childhood self as if in a fantasy.

I had forgotten that such a scene even existed, but I was honestly surprised. Right now, before my eyes, there was a reader who remembered my novel better than me.

"If you think about it, the ending is similar to that novel."

"It seems like that too."

"And the author is Kim Dokja."

In the darkness, Cha Yerin’s eyes were looking at me. She was looking at me, but in a sense she wasn't looking at me.

She was allowing the darkness between us. As if between the lines of darkness, there was an important sentence that the author did not forget to write down.

"A writer is the first reader of his novel."

For a moment, I felt strange.

I felt as if I had heard the answer I had been looking for all along from a distant universe.

"If that’s what you mean, I could also become Kim Dokja."

Why is it that only after becoming Kim Dokja, I hear the story I most wanted to hear as Lee Hakhyun?

"I think Yerin-ssi looks much more like Kim Dokja. The same goes for Sungwoo-ssi, Kyunghwan ahjussi, and Minwoo-ssi."

In reality, they were fragments of 'Kim Dokja'. People who loved this story more than any other readers.

On the other hand, what about me?

I am 49% Kim Dokja. A being that originated from Kim Dokja, who wanted to become Kim Dokja more than anyone else, and therefore could not become Kim Dokja more than anyone else.

In that sense, I may be the person who is furthest from Kim Dokja.

"Perhaps."

After thinking about something for a moment, Yerin opened her mouth. It was dimly bright outside the window, and the light dimly illuminated her face.

"It’s not that we resemble Kim Dokja, but perhaps Kim Dokja resembles us."

I listened to those words in a daze and suddenly opened my mouth.

At that time, the Orbital Elevator stopped with a loud noise.

[Main Scenario #8 – 'Zone 13' has ended automatically.]

Then came the long-awaited reward.

[300,000 coins were obtained as a scenario reward.]

[The story fragment 'Understanding of the Unemployed' was obtained as a scenario reward.]

「Understanding the Unemployed.」

I finally got my hands on this story fragment.

[A new main scenario has arrived.]

Before I knew it, a new scenario area appeared outside the elevator window.

It was a landscape I knew well.

Cha Yerin looked at me with a nervous expression. I nodded at her as if answering her.

She said, "The 'Recycling Center Director' knows who 'Kim Dokja' is."

Otherwise, the stage for the next scenario cannot be here.

"Here is—"

It was then that someone opened the door of the Orbital Elevator. A large hand came through the crack in the door along with a shout.

The moment I reflexively protected Cha Yerin and grabbed the hilt of 'Unbreakable Faith', the owner of the hand completely opened the elevator door.

[I was wondering who it was that rejected my offer.]

A monkey with golden fur was smiling at me.

[Are you the guy called 'Kim Dokja'?]

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 755 Episode 32 Monkey King (2)

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There are a total of four 'Sun Wukong' in the <Star Stream>.

'Sun Wukong' is divided into a total of four depending on the modifier he has.

The first one was 'Meihouwang' who was the Monkey King of Mt. Hwagwa Mountain.

The second is 'Bimawen', who was the stable keeper of the heavenly world.

The third is 'Great Sage Heaven's Equal', whom we know (this guy is the owner of the golden headband).

The fourth is 'Douzhanshengfo', who attained enlightenment at the end of his journey and became Buddha.

Looking at it this way, I felt that he was somehow similar to Kim Dokja. Because Kim Dokja’s existence was divided according to his modifier.

[I asked, are you Kim Dokja?]

"First of all, I am Kim Dokja."

I continued speaking while looking closely at the monkey in front of me.

「Dazzling golden fur. Tattered tiger skin panties. Even his unique eyes that look somewhat drowsy.」

It was definitely true. The monkey in front of me is—

"Are you Meihouwang?"

[This guy. It's quite surprising that you recognize me.]

Meihouwang snorted, placed his hands on his waist and looked triumphant.

Anyway, Meihouwang is a Narrative-grade Constellation that represents the birth of 'Sun Wukong'. According to Kim Dokja, it was the Constellation equivalent of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

However… What is this?

The impact felt by Meihouwang was not large. At first, I thought it was because I was getting stronger, but I didn't think that was the case.

Is he hiding his true power?

That may be so. Because all Sun Wukongs are good at adjusting the level of the story.

But even so, is it possible for Meihouwang, a Narrative-grade Constellation, to appear here in an incarnation body?

I don't know.

Since everything that happens these days completely ignores probability, I now doubt whether probability even exists in this world.

[Is that how you see it?]

I guess I was staring too hard.

King Mifu said while scratching his golden hair.

[Is this guy also in love with my fur? Well, even the Great Sage guy is jealous of my fur. He is a man with eyes to see.]

When he says Great Sage, he probably means Great Sage Heaven’s Equal.

Meihouwang chuckled and said with his deep eyes flashing.

[You probably know why I came.]

"I can guess."

Just a few hours ago, I received a message from the 'Monkey' faction saying they were recruiting me.

And the Meihouwang before my eyes was the famous 'Monkey King'.

[The faction 'Monkey God' invites you.]

In other words, Meihouwang is the master of the 'Monkey God' faction.

It's not another monkey, it's Meihouwang.. The scale of the 'Zodiac Ball' might be bigger than I thought.

[Hmm. Even though I came in person, the response was only that much?]

When I saw Meihouwang's disapproving expression, I thought it was a pity. I should have asked to take a picture together.

[Insolent bastard, come join my forces.]

Meihouwang, like Sun Wukong, didn't even listen to my answer and just kept talking.

[I liked your story. I allow you to become my incarnation.]

To be honest, it would be a lie if I said there wasn't a part that tempted me.

He is the incarnation body of Meihouwang.

If I wasn't the incarnation of the 'Demon King of Salvation', I might have been quite attracted to it.

If I can persuade Meihouwang to succeed in the '4-stage union of Sun Wukong' and then evolve him into 'The AncientLiberator', I will have the strongest Mythical Constellation in history as my sponsor.

Of course, it was a wrong assumption at this point.

"I'm sorry, but I already have a Constellation—"

[Hmph, I already know that your idiot sponsor is away. Are you ignoring me?]

"Even if he is away, once you are behind someone , you are always behind them."

It wasn't even in my mind, but Kim Dokja would have said this. As expected, Meihouwang's reaction was not bad.

[This guy is more loyal than I thought. I like it.]

"Thank you for your understanding."

[If that's the case, I will directly order 'cancellation of the Constellation Contract'.]

"Yes?"

It occurred to me later that I had made a mistake. Meihouwang is Sun Wukong, who has the most eccentric personality among his brothers. He was a 'King of Monkeys' who did whatever he wanted to do.

Just as I was wondering what kind of incredible lie I had to tell to avoid this situation—

A skein of shining golden thread flew from somewhere.

The skein of thread wrapped exactly around Meihouwang's head. The sound of an order was heard afterwards. Meihouwang, who was holding his head, let out an undignified scream.

[Ngegegegegegegegye—]

[The story 'Monkey Seal' begins its storytelling.]

It's a story about overpowering 'Meihouwang'.

[Okay! I knew!]

With a 'pop' sound, Meihouwang turned into a small monkey. Meihouwang, who was glaring at me disapprovingly, did a somersault, jumped backwards sharply, and climbed on top of a woman.

The woman smiled bitterly at Meihouwang, who shouted "Ukkkkkkk".

"I told you not to do that, right?"

A unique, clear voice that reassures people.

I often thought,

If Yoo Sangah existed in reality, she might have been that person.

Another person in this world who calls me 'writer'.

"Have you written any side stories in the meantime, author?"

Editor Ji Eunyu was there.

---

Ji Eunyu and I parted ways during the fierce battle at the Washington Dome. At that time, she had neither the time nor the presence of mind to say hello.

On one side, the Demon King of Salvation was dying, and on the other side, Yoo Joonghyuk, who had become a black beast, was running rampant.

[The Constellation 'Meihouwang' looks at you with disapproving eyes.]

Fortunately, there was only one monkey running wild right now, and even that monkey had calmed down in Ji Eunyu's arms.

Perhaps it was because she had subdued Meihouwang, but it seemed as if a halo could be seen behind Ji Eunyu's back.

"Your spirit has turned white."

"Author, it looks like you’re having a hard time."

"Is it noticeable even though I’m wearing a mask?"

"Yes, I can see it."

We exchanged casual greetings and smiled at each other.

There is a unique feeling of relief when I am with Ji Eunyu. I feel like it's okay even if I make mistakes.

My editor not only finds spelling and spacing, but also finds sentences I forgot to write.

She could tell whether I was confident in my writing by reading just a few sentences of the manuscript.

"It’s noticeable."

That's what Ji Eunyu said when I asked her how she knew.

"Editor. I have a lot to ask. Especially…"

Ji Eunyu noticed my sidelong glance at Meihouwang and cleared her throat slightly.

"Have you forgotten who my sponsor is?"

A bit late, a series of information came to mind.

As far as I know, the Constellation that Ji Eunyu signed a contract with was 'Lotus Flower Blooming Under the Moonlight'— 'Yoo Sangah, the Emperor of the Moonlight', a member of <Kim Dokja Company>.

"I chose 'Monkey' among the zodiac signs. I thought that would be the easiest to conquer."

In the story, Yoo Sangah goes through the 'Island of the Reincarnated' and is resurrected through the incarnation of Tang Sanzang(?).

In fact, most of the 'Yeonhwadae' and related skills used by Yoo Sangah are borrowed from Sanzang’s tale.

The metaphor is a judgment.

"If I go to the 'Monkey' faction, I can use my sponsor’s story."

I was secretly impressed.

"But the monkey force could have been without Sun Wukong."

"This is the 'Recycling Center'. I thought Sun Wukong would definitely be there. Instead, it’s the somewhat unpopular Sun Wukong."

Indeed, the power of reasoning to find even unwritten sentences.

[The Constellation 'Meihouwang' is complaining that he is ignored again!]

Ji Eunyu gently scratched Meihouwang’s chin and continued her words.

"And when I got to the monkey area, there was this big cave. I was immediately convinced."

"Huagua Mountain Convergence Cave."

"Yes, there was this person there."

Who would have guessed that the 'Monkey Area' of the Chinese zodiac was the birthplace of Meihouwang?

It was undoubtedly an excellent place for 'Recycling'.

"Author, you didn’t choose any faction, right?"

"Yes."

"I knew you would. Because you’re the type of person who only takes the hardest path."

"It really wasn’t easy this time."

"Still, you definitely feel different than before. Your back seems to have straightened a bit."

"Is that so?"

I looked down at my body again. Now that I think about it, I feel like my body has improved a little.

"I understand that you went around having fun without writing what you were told to write."

Although I heard some nagging, meeting Ji Eunyu here was a blessing.

From the looks of it, Meihouwang doesn't seem to have any particular hostility towards us.

[Level 2 of the exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' is activated.]

It was then that I suddenly heard a skill activation message.

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint has never been activated in this way, so maybe it's the influence of the 'Constellation Act'.]

I could hear someone's inner thoughts in my head.

「Who is it.」

I immediately knew whose thoughts those were. This person doesn't use question marks even when thinking.

「She called him writer.」

"By the way, I’m late for the introduction. Editor, this is Cha Yerin. Yerin, this is my editor."

But this time, I heard the other side’s inner thoughts.

「Writer, is it okay to say that?」

There were a little too many 'inner feelings'.

「Did he reveal that he was a writer?」

「Then it’ll be a little bit difficult, right?」

Yes. therefore.

「If it’s someone he can trust, it’ll be okay.」

「But Kim Dokja didn’t reveal his identity until much later.」

Let me explain.

「What if that person betrays us?」

「I think we need to come up with a separate response plan.」

「As a first measure—」

I quickly intervened before Ji Eunyu’s plan of action could progress any further.

"Editor, this person is my reader. You can rest assured."

"Ah."

"I revealed my secret. She is my only reader."

"The only… reader?"

I happened to express it that way, but it wasn't wrong.

Cha Yerin is probably the only person who read and remembers my debut work.

「Then what about me?」

Eh?

"Nice to meet you. I'm Ji Eunyu. I'm the person who reads and edits the author's writing before anyone else."

Only then did I suddenly come to my senses.

Come to think of it, Cha Yerin wasn't the only one. Although she may not have read my debut novel, Ji Eunyu was a reader who read my novels before anyone else and read them more.

"I'm Cha Yerin. I've read all of his novels."

Ji Eunyu's expression changed completely after hearing Cha Yerin's introduction.

"You've read all of the Author's novels?"

"Yes."

"Even the Genesis trilogy?"

"Yes."

"You're a complete Kim Dokja."

"Kim Dokja…"

Cha Yerin awkwardly looked down at her toes.

Now I understand. That's an embarrassing expression.

"What path did you take when reading the book?"

"I read it in paperback first, but I bought it all later. The serial version, the copy, and—"

"Wow! Thank you so much! What are you doing, writer? You need to thank her quickly."

"Thank you."

I suddenly said thanks to her.

"Louder! She’s the one who saved our management from almost being ruined!"

"Thank you!"

"If you need an autographed copy, please let me know anytime! I don’t have the book right now, but—"

When I thought about it, this was Ji Eunyu’s true self. I was worried for no reason.

[The Constellation 'Meihouwang' yawns, saying he doesn’t know what you are talking about.]

[The Constellation 'Meihouwang' urges you to proceed with the scenario quickly.]

"Look at that. Come to think of it, this wasn’t the time."

"Yes, well. Let’s leave our greetings like this."

"Do you know where this place is?"

In response to Ji Eunyu’s question, I looked around at the surrounding scenery.

"Yes. I know."

A landscape covered in clouds everywhere.

「This is the place where Kim Dokja waited for the carriage during the 'Constellation Banquet'.」

The name of this place is 'Cloud Road'.

A place that serves as a tributary and station connecting the scenarios of the <Star Stream>. That means,

"The carriage will be here soon."

As if to prove my thoughts, I saw something like a small dot flying from afar in the sky. The dot grew bigger little by little, and as expected, it took on the shape of a carriage.

Cha Yerin said with admiration.

"A carriage like that came during the Constellation Banquet."

At that time, it was Apollo's golden chariot.

The carriage coming this time was also a luxurious golden carriage.

The difference was that this time it was the little rats that were pulling the carriage.

[The Constellation 'Meihouwang' is complaining that the organizers have used their coins in the wrong place again.]

A golden carriage at the 'Recycling Center'. Perhaps in which scenario was that used first?

[New sub-scenario has arrived!]

**<Sub Scenario - Orient Express Wagon>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: S++

Clear conditions: Get on the carriage. Arrive at your destination safely.

Time limit: 2 hours

Reward: 'Zodiac Ball' admission ticket.

Failure: Death.

On the outside, it was such a peaceful scenario that one wondered if this could even be a scenario. But.

"Is this it?"

Ji Eunyu asked.

"That’s it."

I answered.

As any aspiring Killer King knows, the carriage Kim Dokja is riding in in the 'Constellations' Banquet' is attacked by Constellations and crashes.

The mere fact that 'riding on a carriage' came up as a scenario means that this carriage will inevitably suffer the same fate.

Above all, the meaningful sentence 'arrive at your destination safely' proved this.

I smiled bitterly and opened my mouth.

"There is no way to get over this easily."

"Who can I blame?"

"Yes?"

"I told you when I was serializing. Sometimes you need an easy scenario so readers can take a break."

I didn't know it would come back to me like this either.

"I was wrong."

Even the difficulty level of the sub-scenario is S++.

At this point, I suspect that the 'Recycling Center's Director' may also be a possessed person.

A carriage that strangely resembled Apollo's golden carriage finally stopped in front of me. The squeaking rats lowered their heads as if to say hello.

The moment I put my hand on the carriage door handle to board, a message came out.

[Only designated incarnations can ride this carriage.]

[Story fragment 'Facial Recognition' is activated.]

It's a carriage with a 'face recognition' function.

Was it by any chance made in <Emperor>?

Ji Eunyu and Cha Yerin, who completed facial recognition, boarded in turn, followed by my turn.

[Face recognition failed.]

I thought it was broken, but when I thought about it, I was still wearing the mask. It's not even a metaphorical object for the carriage, so no one would recognize me wearing a mask.

Now that the Zone 13 scenario was over, there was no reason to insist on masking any longer.

[Release the 'mask'.]

As I took off my mask for the first time in a while, the stuffy feeling disappeared and cool air enveloped my face.

I relaxed my neck for a moment and lightly rolled my shoulders, but my face felt strangely hot.

When I looked up, Ji Eunyu and Cha Yerin were looking at me with surprised eyes.

[The Constellation Meihouwang is looking at you blankly.]

The same was true for Meihouwang, who was sitting on Ji Eunyu’s head.

What followed was Meihouwang’s voice heard in my ears.

[This guy. That’s interesting.]

My face was reflected in the carriage window that slowly opened.

I stared at this face for a long time, even forgetting that I had to get on the carriage.

The person I possessed was clearly Cheon Inho. However,

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' smiles with satisfaction as he looks at you.]

Reflected in the window, I was wearing Kim Dokja’s face.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 756 Episode 32 Monkey King (3)

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The scenery of the cloud road flowed outside the window.

Someday, Kim Dokja must have seen the same scene. What was Kim Dokja thinking as he passed this road?

I don't know.

At that time, Kim Dokja was riding with the symbolic form of Dionysus.

Maybe he was too busy wondering whether the wine in Dionysus's cup was real.

The two didn't ask why I had Kim Dokja's face.

Just as Kim Dokja did not ask whether the wine in Dionysus's glass was his urine or not.

All I hear in my ears is the squeak of rats running on the cloud road and the sound of the wind blowing gently.

As I slowly took my eyes off the window, I made eye contact with Cha Yerin.

"Are you okay?"

I nodded and answered.

"I'm okay."

"But it’s Kim Dokja's face."

The reason she immediately recognized this face was probably because it resembled Kim Dokja, who appeared on the cover of the original novel.

"Yes. This is Kim Dokja’s face."

I felt like it was a stupid conversation, but I had no other way to respond. Because I really had Kim Dokja’s face.

"He’s more handsome than I thought."

"Yes?"

"His assumption was correct."

"Kill… what did Seongwoo-ssi say?"

"Kim Dokja is not 'ugly' but 'ugly'."

I belatedly remembered the nickname given to Kim Dokja.

'The Ugliest King.'

If you think about it, the first title Kim Dokja received was not 'Demon King of Salvation' but 'The Ugliest King'.

Ji Eunyu, who was listening to the story nearby, asked.

"What does that mean?"

"Ugly is just being ugly, but 'ugly' means not fully formed."

"Aha."

It was a pretty subtle difference.

Of course, from my point of view as the person who wrote that expression, I wonder what the specific intention was...

As if reading my thoughts, Ji Eunyu answered.

"But I don’t think there was any particular intention—"

"What are you talking about, editor? It was all perfectly intentional. Above all, Kim Dokja was blocked from external perception by the [Fourth Wall]! Other people couldn’t see Kim Dokja’s face properly!"

After hearing my explanation, Cha Yerin shook her head in admiration.

"But even though there is a [Fourth Wall], I can still see the Author’s face."

"Well, I don’t have the [Fourth Wall]…"

As I spoke up to that point, I stopped.

Now I am the representative of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Even though the [Fourth Wall] was activated, there was nothing strange about it at all.

"Open up, Fourth Wall."

There was no particular [Fourth Wall] response to my command.

Ji Eunyu asked in a suspicious voice.

"If you do that, it will open?"

"I just gave it a try. But can you see my face clearly now?"

"Yes. What about Yerin-ssi?"

"It looks good."

Does this mean that the [Fourth Wall] is not working properly?

[The attributes' window cannot be activated due to a current system error.]

However, the 'attributes' window' is still not visible.

Ji Eunyu, who was quietly observing my face, continued speaking.

"Yerin-ssi, you said that the Author looks like Kim Dokja right now, right?"

"Yes."

"It’s a little surprising. It doesn’t look that way to me."

I asked, wondering what this was all about.

"So how do you see it?"

"It just looks like the original Author’s face."

"My face?"

"It’s not exact, but I think so. Author, didn’t you always look like this? Your hair style is very different, but…"

There was a question that immediately came to mind.

「What did I originally look like?」

Has it been too long since I possessed a character? Even when I saw my face reflected in the window and touched it again, my old face did not come to mind.

It feels like my face has been like this from the beginning.

I felt scared for a moment because of that sentiment, which did not feel the slightest sense of discomfort.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is looking at you.]

I couldn't tell these two people.

The 'story' I have is said to be eating up 'Kim Dokja’s fragments', and to the extent that I have eaten those fragments, I am becoming more like Kim Dokja.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' opens its eyes greedily.]

Even now, my story is coveting the two people in front of me.

「If you touch either of them, I will never speak of you again.」

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' frowns and steps away.]

Fortunately, the story quickly quieted down.

However, in that short period of time, there were people who witnessed the altercation between me and my story.

[I never thought there would be someone who was like us in this universe.]

It was Meihouwang. Meihouwang delivered his mantra in the form of a telephonic voice so that the other two could not hear it.

[When one being becomes many, problems arise. Get your mind straight. If you don’t want to be preyed upon by 'just one story'.]

Just one story.

I didn't expect to hear these words here, so I suddenly looked at him. However, Meihouwang seemed to have no intention of saying more, and he yawned repeatedly, hiding his bored expression.

[Wake me up when you arrive.]

Meihouwang soon took a deep breath and fell asleep in Ji Eunyu's arms.

And as soon as he fell asleep, a small display appeared above the carriage window.

[Welcome aboard the 'Orient Express Wagon'.]

I thought it was just a golden carriage, but the internal facilities are state-of-the-art. Well, I should have looked into it from the moment the fragment of the 「Fingerprint Recognition」 story was attached.

The carriage traveling on the cloudy road felt like it was tilting for a moment.

[After a while, the carriage changes to 'manual operation'.]

No, suddenly?

As soon as the message ended, a controller appeared out of thin air. It was the same controller we commonly use when playing games.

['Zodiac Ball' participants must operate the 'controller' to drive the carriage themselves.]

[The destination is displayed on the panel.]

[You may attack or be attacked by another carriage on the way to your destination.]

[Special prizes will be awarded to the passengers of the carriage that reach the destination in first place.]

At the same time, a huge panel appears before my eyes. There was a dot on the panel marking the location of our carriage.

In addition to us, what appeared to be carriages were moving nearby.

Maybe there's a carriage with Killer King or Lee Dansu among them.

[After 30 seconds, 'manual driving' will begins.]

30 seconds. There isn't much time.

I quickly looked back at Ji Eunyu and opened my mouth.

"Editor-nim."

"Yes. Are you asking me to knock you out?"

I don't know how Ji Eunyu knew, but she was already pulling out a large hammer from her pocket.

Cha Yerin also said, clashing her iron fists together.

"If it’s about knocking someone out, I’m good at it."

I looked at them for a moment and then answered.

"I’ll just do it myself."

I was lucky that this wasn't 'Zone 13'.

Because from now on, I can freely use skills.

"I’m going to pass out for 30 seconds from now."

[This area is a place where 'skill' use is permitted.]

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' is activated!]

[Your understanding of the story fragment 'Incite' is very excellent.]

[The story fragment 'Incite' has a great influence on the proficiency of skill 'Incite'.]

With the feeling of my consciousness sinking, I activated [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' stage 2 is activated!]

Let's see.

Let’s check Yoo Joonghyuk’s side first.

As I thought of Yoo Joonghyuk, the boy from the 41st round, in my head, the inside of another carriage appeared before my eyes.

「"That guy must be in a carriage too."」

The conditions for activating the skill have been met. It seems he also thought of me.

And the one who rode with Yoo Joonghyuk—

「'If you say that guy, do you mean Kim Dokja?"」

Damn it, why is it Killer King?

The boy Yoo Joonghyuk and Killer King were staring at each other while sitting across from each other in the carriage.

「"Why do you call Kim Dokja 'that guy'?"」

「"It’s what feels right in my heart."」

「"Only close friends use that title. You and Kim Dokja are not close. It's actually me who is close."」

「"You don't seem that close either."」

The two growled as if they were going to fight at any moment, and then looked at the controller that appeared in the air and spoke at the same time.

「"I'll do it."」

I immediately switched the screen.

It would have been a lie if I said we weren't there, but after thinking about it, I thought there wouldn't be that much of a problem if these two were a team.

That's because Yoo Joonghyuk's characteristic was that he was a pro gamer, and Killer King was also talented at games.

The problem was with the other team.

「"Aaaah! Dokja-ssi, what should I do? What should I do!"」

Cruelly, Kyung Sein was already calling my name.

Next, the sacrificial face of Lee Dansu appeared before my eyes.

As expected, Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi were on the same team.

I used [Group Chat] to talk to them.

—Have either of you played a game before?

Then, Dansu ahjussi and Kyung Sein looked up into the sky at the same time.

「"Wow, is this really what Kim Dokja is talking about? Is this [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]?"」

—Yes. Please let me know quickly as we are running out of time.

「"Hmm, I haven't had any talent for games since I was young—"」

「"Well, I like games, but I'm not good at controlling them… so my friends don't always join me…"」

Damn, it seemed like that too.

At that moment, several other carriages were approaching the carriage they were riding in. No matter how I looked at it, it didn't seem like they were approaching with good intentions.

—Be careful!

The window of the carriage running side by side opened and a barrage of sharp shuriken flew in.

「"Waaaaaaah!"」

The shurikens scraped against the carriage with a crunching sound. At a glance, it was an attack filled with powerful magical power.

[The durability of the carriage has decreased!]

I couldn't leave it like this.

[There are 10 seconds left to stay in a stunned state .]

I made a quick decision.

"I will pass out for one more minute."

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' is activated!]

[Stun time is extended!]

[The usage time of the exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' stage 2, is extended!]

—Hold your controller! Hurry!

Kyung Sein grabbed the controller and attempted to accelerate. The distance between the carriages did not increase. Rather, the carriages naturally surrounded them as if they were playing a game.

As the shurikens flew in from both sides and scratched the wheels of the carriage, the inside of the carriage shook as if it would overturn at any moment.

The screams of Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi were heard.

Then, pale smoke began to rise from the front of the carriage.

[Warning! The carriage's durability is below 20%!]

As the carriage slowed down, other carriages passed them mockingly. Fortunately, it appears that they did not intend to finish off the carriage.

By the way, those carriages seem strangely fast—

[The Constellation 'Liverless Rabbit' is grinning.]

[The story fragment 'Running Rabbit' begins its storytelling.]

[The carriage receives acceleration correction from the story.]

Damn it, it had to be the carriage with the 'Rabbit' version.

Other carriages nearby also passed their carriage.

[Warning. The carriage of incarnation that arrives last at the 'destination' cannot enter the 'Zodiac Ball'.]

The expressions of Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi hardened at the message they heard.

[All passengers on a carriage that does not arrive at the 'destination' will die.]

These were the rules of this game.

It is a game in which incarnations who do not reach the destination are 'certainly destined to die'.

That was the 'Orient Express Carriage'.

And if things continue like this, there is a high probability that Dansu ahjussi and Kyung Sein's carriage will not be able to avoid last place.

I opened my mouth urgently.

—Ahjussi, use a story.

「"If it's a story—"」

—Have you forgotten what 'animal mask' you are wearing?

At that moment, Dansu ahjussi's eyes widened.

Lee Dansu finally realized it too.

An animal that runs slowly but steadily.

And at least an animal that doesn't lose to 'rabbits'.

—You might not know this from other Chinese zodiac signs, but no matter what happens, the turtle never loses to the rabbit.

「"But will the stage work properly?"」

—Of course. Because.

Because the conditions for staging this story have just been met.

[The story fragment 'The Turtle Incubating Someone Else's Egg' begins its storytelling.]

[The story fragment 'The Turtle Incubating Someone Else’s Egg' encounters the story 'Running Rabbit'.]

[The story 'The Hare and the Tortoise' begins.]

Along with the unfolding stage scene, the carriage's durability gauge began to rise little by little.

[The story 'The Hare and the Tortoise' repairs the 'Orient Express Wagon'.]

The speed of the carriage was also gradually increasing. A carriage that moves steadily at an honest but regular pace.

Before I knew it, the carriages that had passed ahead began to come into view.

「"Okay, okay! I'm really catching up!"」

Done. Now, as long as you drive well, this carriage will reach its destination without any problems.

「"Hmm."」

The voice that suddenly came was not that of Dansu ahjussi or that of Kyung Sein.

Is it because I'm too focused on the external situation? I didn't notice that there was a passenger in their carriage with them.

When I looked closely, I saw that the passenger was someone I knew.

「"You."」

Bicheonhori

「"You can already use the power of the Oldest Dream."」

He opened his mouth as if he could see me floating in the air.

「"But you’d better not abuse that power."」

How did Bicheonhori notice that I was here?

Bicheonhori silently pointed his finger behind me.

「"Dokja-ssi."」

Someone's voice coming from behind, from very far away.

A voice that seems to place a heavy weight on the heart.

Right. [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] was this skill. That,

「"Dokja hyung!"」

It was a curse.

「"Ahjussi!"」

They were calling me.

Bicheonhori smiled as if he wanted to see that.

「"You can’t become a 'rRecorder' yet. With so many voices holding onto you, how can you write the next story of this world?"」

Even after hearing those words, I couldn't help but look back.

Now I am the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

This is because it was a Constellation that loved stories more than anyone else in this world.

「"Kim Dokja."」

The moment I looked back, the scenery of the story changed once again.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 757 Episode 32 Monkey King (4)

Forgetting that you are even reading a sentence.

Getting sucked into the story, becoming the main character, and the main character becoming me.

[Your 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' has reached a certain level.]

There is a saying that refers to the magical moment that everyone experiences while reading a book.

[You reach the realm of pendulum experience.]

Pendulum experience.

Beyond the walls of paper and text, recognizing other people's experiences as if they were your own.

[The Void Curtain is looking at you.]

All I have to do is skip to one more chapter.

I had a feeling that there was a next story beyond this that I wanted to see so much.

【■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■You can’t get over it】

At that time, someone grabbed my back.

Just need to go a little further. The story I want is right there.

Then something inside me answered.

【It only takes a moment. Because I’m not really going to pass.】

【No one can defy probability】

Something inside me spoke once again.

【For the sake of this great 'record', please turn a blind eye just once.】

For a moment, time seemed to freeze. It feels like a very distant part of the universe is slowly nodding its head.

A sheet of paper was passed slowly. It's so thick that it takes my breath away. After barely flipping through the paper, I finally found the one sentence I was looking for.

「Yoo Joonghyuk, sitting cross-legged, recalled a memory from a long time ago.」

I started reading the sentence.

---

Yoo Joonghyuk, sitting cross-legged, recalled a memory from a long time ago.

It is a journey to retrieve Kim Dokja. Memories of swimming through space with Biyoo. A story from the time when Han Sooyoung's novels were used and their stories were spread throughout the universe.

The arduous journey gradually made Yoo Joonghyuk tired, and he worked harder to forget that he was getting tired.

He had to move.

[Captain, let’s rest here for a moment.]

With Biyoo, he sat on an unfamiliar bench in an unfamiliar place on an unfamiliar planet and looked up at the familiar sky.

Looking at the sky like that, Yoo Joonghyuk felt that the path they had walked was very unfamiliar.

Will they really be able to meet Kim Dokja again at the end of this road? Is that poor guy really alive with them?

[Sometimes you need to rest.]

Yoo Joonghyuk thought about the stars that didn't talk to him. He reminisced about his lost sponsor and imagined another self who had reached his ■■ — 'Secretive Plotter'.

Will a moment like that of 'Secretive Plotter' come to him?

Will there be some kind of salvation at the end of this difficult life?

Yoo Joonghyuk could hardly imagine. His ■■ was as distant as Kim Dokja's now blurred face.

Will he know when this trip is over?

Why was he born, lived, and continues to live in this world?

[Captain, have you ever thought about that?]

Yoo Joonghyuk answered Biyoo's question half a beat late.

"What."

[I think there might be a happy universe in which all these tragedies did not occur.]

Happy universe, Yoo Joonghyuk thought about that strange word for a moment and said.

"If it weren’t for all those tragedies, we wouldn’t be where we are today."

Biyoo pursed her lips as if she hadn't asked that and then added.

[But sometimes you can imagine a different world.]

"What world are you talking about?"

[In that world, there are no scenarios, and the stars don't talk to you. But there is tragedy in that world too.]

"..."

[The biggest tragedy in that world is oversleeping and being late for school.]

Yoo Joonghyuk silently listened to Biyoo.

[Plus, the lunch menu that day is a tasteless meal. I went to a PC room with the money I spent on supplies and got caught by my parents.]

Yoo Joonghyuk briefly imagined the world described by Biyoo.

However, such a world was not depicted very well.

Because he never went to school properly, never ate lunch without worrying about the taste, and his parents never existed.

"You are the Dokkaebi King now. Why do you miss those things?"

[Why? Can’t I miss it?]

Hearing that question, Yoo Joonghyuk looked back on his old memories. A face suddenly came to mind.

A girl who often smiled brightly. A child who always called him 'Captain' and followed him.

“You were Shin Yoosung of the 41st Round."

[Well, if you look at the origin, yes.]

"Are you still blaming me?"

Yoo Joonghyuk remembered Shin Yoosung, the 'Disaster of Floods'. She came to the past to change the future, but Shin Yoosung was disappointed in him. Shin Yoosung tried to kill him.

He will never forget the look in her eyes.

[No. I can’t even remember those times very well.]

The girl who was reincarnated as a dokkaebi, burying all resentment and hatred, spoke.

As Yoo Joonghyuk watched such a Biyoo, he felt an unknown emotion.

So where does Shin Yoosung's 41st Round go now? What will now fill the space where all hatred and resentment have disappeared?

As if understanding Yoo Joonghyuk's doubts, Biyoo spoke.

[It's not that bad to have gaps in your memory. Because that blank space can be filled with other imagination.]

"In the 41st Round, I did something I couldn't take back."

[It may have been so. But there weren't only bad things in that Round.]

Biyoo muttered as if retracing the traces of the disappeared 41st Round.

[So, try to imagine as much fun as possible. In fact, there must have been a very cool adventure in the 41st Round. It's just that the Captain, I, and everyone else forgot.]

"…"

[Do you know? I may have been in school in that Round. The Captain could have come to my graduation ceremony.]

Of course, such a thing could not have been possible, but Biyoo continued.

[Maybe there was a Dokja in that Round as well.]

"It's impossible."

[I'm just imagining it. Because it's fun to imagine.]

Yoo Joonghyuk thought about himself in the 41st Round.

He doesn't know how he felt or what he felt during the 41st Round.

Why did he send Shin Yoosung to the past? What kind of tragedy did he face that made him think that was the only solution?

[It gets serious again. They say have fun imagining things! Don't you think so?]

Yoo Joonghyuk looked out into the street in silence. The sun set late in the day. Students were seen leaving school as the sunset broke over thread-like stream.

"I won't."

[Don't you think the captain will have a dream life too?]

It's the life he dreamed of. If there was such a thing, his life should have been different when the scenario ended.

[Well, if there was such a thing, the captain wouldn't have been unemployed. The captain is also really pitiful.]

"I am neither pitiful nor unemployed."

[That's right. Imagination does that.]

"It’s not my imagination. I’ve always trained with the sword."

[What were you planning on doing with your sword training?]

What were you trying to do by training your sword? Yoo Joonghyuk had nothing to say in response.

There was no longer a Constellation in the sky that he had seen. There was no one who would acknowledge him for training with the sword.

[Did you try to become a kendo player like Heewon-ssi?]

"I don’t plan on doing that."

[Then you are just an unemployed person who is good at using a sword.]

Why did he train with the sword?

The moment when Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been contemplating for a long time, was barely able to come up with an answer. .

"I—"

The voices of boys and girls were heard from below thread-like stream. One girl said, "Let’s go to the PC room!" She shouted, and the other boy frowned. Then the slim, white boy put a headlock on the frowning boy.

"Ah! Let’s go!"

The moment he heard the boy's voice, Yoo Joonghyuk jumped up from his seat.

[Captain?]

Yoo Joonghyuk started going down the hill. The legs that had been moving slowly became faster and faster. Yoo Joonghyuk ran to the boy, forgetting that he was out of breath, and grabbed him by the shoulder.

The boy frowned and looked back at him.

"Who are you?"

"What is it, ahjussi?"

The blunt-looking boy grabbed Yoo Joonghyuk's arm, and as if protecting the boy, the girl frowned menacingly at Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk quickly let go of his hand.

"I'm sorry. I saw wrong."

The boy and girl grumbled slightly and set out on the road again.

Looking at their somewhat unfamiliar yet familiar backs, Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly imagined something like that.

"Maybe that boy."

As Biyoo says, isn't that boy also Kim Dokja, who was reborn after forgetting all his tragedies at the end of his reincarnation?

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the boy and girl next to him. A blunt boy with a strangely similar vibe to him, and a girl with tear spots like Han Sooyoung.

Of course, those children were neither Yoo Joonghyuk nor Han Sooyoung. Even though he knew this, Yoo Joonghyuk continued to feel strange.

What if there really is a story like that somewhere in this universe?

Biyoo's voice laughing softly tickled his ears.

[Look at that. Even the Captain has a story he imagines.]

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly opened his eyes and woke up from the turbulent storm of his memories.

Pure white steam rose from his whole body as he sat cross-legged. The wounds from the fierce battle with Odin had turned black.

'I overdid it.'

Yoo Joonghyuk recalled the last fierce battle. Receiving Odin's spear, cutting down the legendary Constellations of <Asgard>, crashing the incarnation into the void curtain, and being swept away by the aftereffects of probability.

If 'Monarch Slayer' Jaehwan had not helped him, he would have been swept away by the storm of probability and would not have been able to return.

'Monarch Slayer.'

Yoo Joonghyuk thought about Jaehwan. The miracle of rebirth was not felt anywhere in the vicinity. He's a guy who can't catch the original species, so he might be traveling all over the Star Stream again.

'You wasted too much probability. It wasn't a probability to be used here.'

Originally, he planned to save this probability and save it again and then explode it at an important time.

If Kim Dokja's presence had not been felt in 'Washington Dome', he would not have made such a risky choice.

「Kim Dokja.」

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk thought of that name, he suddenly felt a familiar feeling.

A feeling that someone is watching him. Yoo Joonghyuk knew what this feeling was.

A unique skill possessed by that guy who only talks about it, that magically appeared whenever and wherever he thought about it.

Yoo Joonghyuk reflexively looked up into space.

---

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me, I was shocked and changed the screen.

Wow, I’m surprised.

It was really that 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.

I couldn't believe it. I couldn't understand how this was possible.

Nevertheless, if I were to explain it somehow, the situation I was in now was as follows.

「I am the ‘world line’ from [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint]. I crossed the wall.」

A voice from another world line reached my ears, and I followed that voice, crossed the wall of the world line, and came to this place—that is, to the place where 'Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja Company>' is.

I don't know what's going on, but just knowing that this happened in reality made my heart race.

What if I could observe other <Kim Dokja Company> members like I observed Yoo Joonghyuk?

No, beyond observation—

「"Dokja ahjussi."」

If only I could tell them my 'story'.

「"Dokja ahjussi."」

If I follow this voice, will I be able to meet the others?

I concentrated once again. Then, my field of vision slowly cleared and a new landscape was revealed.

Somehow, familiar voices were heard in the hazy atmosphere.

"Noona, why isn’t this showing anything?"

"Hmm. Biyoo said it could definitely be seen this way."

"Isn’t the Other Worlds Device broken?"

"Hey! Lee Gilyoung! Don’t kick that!"

"The sooty bastard did this before and it was okay."

"Master, really. Unnie, where is the broadcast area for this?"

"It was the Gourmet Association."

"Shall I come and beat up the Gourmet Association kids?"

"Ah, it’s coming out! The screen is coming out!"

And after a while.

"Ahjussi! It’s him!"

"He really looks just like Dokja ahjussi."

"But the situation doesn’t look good…"

"No, why is that guy passed out over there? Doesn’t someone really have to go help?"

"External Constellations cannot intervene in the Recycling Center."

"But we can’t just leave him like that!"

I suddenly opened my eyes. I saw familiar faces huddled together in front of a small display.

I unconsciously reach out to them...

…I have hands?

I felt sensations all over my body.

How on earth did this happen?

I moved my neck, which was not working well, and checked my hands and feet.

Hands and feet that are unbelievably smaller than mine.

Then a woman with beautiful brown hair turned to me.

In person, the face resembles Ji Eunyu even more.

"kkoma Dokja, are you awake?"

I was suddenly lifted into the air, fully understanding the feelings of Meihouwang, who was held in Ji Eunyu's arms.

"I want to hug him too!"

"You’re awake?"

Two children running. Looking at that scenery, I felt an unknown emotion overflowing with me.

"Shall we watch it together?"

The screen my companions were watching came into view along with a friendly voice. On the screen, there is a fainted figure and Ji Eunyu driving a carriage as well as Cha Yerin .

「"Yerin-ssi. Do you know how to drive?"」

「"I am a minor."」

In a landscape that had no sense of reality, it was only then that I realized what had happened to me.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' reacts.]

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' is taking a liking to the 'Kim Dokja Fragment' that you possessed.]

Small hands, small feet. A small body that is difficult to get up on its own.

It was definitely true.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint Level 3' is in effect.]

I have become 'kkoma Kim Dokja' raised by Kim Dokja Company.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 758 Episode 32 Monkey King (5)

Why on earth is kkoma Kim Dokja here?

"I’m glad that everyone likes him."

When I turned my head, I saw Lee Jihye playing the Hwipirang. Even her facial expression was different from the younger Lee Jihye in the 41st Round.

Lee Jihye of <Kim Dokja Company> overcomes all her scenarios and eventually overcomes even her own sponsor to become the 'Monarch of the Sea'.

"I worked hard to collect your fragments."

「Through Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, her inner thoughts were heard at times.」

[Your understanding of the person in question is insufficient.]

Even though I couldn't hear it completely, it was enough to understand the situation.

「In addition to the 41st Round, there was a universe where 'Kim Dokja fragments' were scattered.」

And Lee Jihye seems to have collected the 'Kim Dokja fragments' scattered throughout that universe.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' finds it appetizing.]

Perhaps this 'kkoma Kim Dokja' is a kind of artificial life form created from the fragments of Kim Dokja.

Crucially, this 'kkoma Kim Dokja' could be felt as a soul. That's probably why I was able to possess it.

The child who was lightly patting my cheek muttered.

"Did you look like this when you were young?"

"You were cute when you were young."

Shin Yoosung and Lee Gilyoung.

I slowly looked at their faces.

In reality, it was my first time seeing these faces, but the feeling of familiarity was probably because I had already met Shin Yoosung in the 41st Round.

"If you say one word, I will kill you all."

No, maybe I had also met 'Shin Yoosung' before my eyes.

「"You're Kim Dokja."」

This girl possessed herself in the 41st Round and saved me several times.

I carefully held the hand of the girl who was squeezing mine. It was only a subtle level of grip strength, but even with that, Shin Yoosung could sense something on my face.

"What."

Shin Yoosung, who had been looking at me blankly, suddenly tilted her head.

"Ahjussi?"

Lee Seolhwa, who was watching the situation from afar, approached.

"Why?"

"Is it an illusion... I think the little man’s condition has just changed."

In response to Shin Yoosung's words, Lee Seolhwa pulled up my top and took the stethoscope.

"Well, let’s see."

Doctor Lee Seolhwa.

A person who looks almost no different from the 41st Round just by face alone. The difference was the depth of her expression.

Lee Seolhwa in the 41st Round had a strangely strong spirit of experimentation, while Lee Seolhwa in <Kim Dokja Company> had the air of a seeker who was well versed in all the truths of the universe.

Lee Seolhwa’s eyes met mine and drew a soft arc.

"The story’s condition is stable."

A doctor who steadfastly took care of the group even in places where Kim Dokja's eyes could not reach.

As Kim Dokja expressed, without her, <Kim Dokja Company> would not have been able to reach the final scenario.

Shin Yoosung urgently grabbed my hand and comforted me.

"Ahjussi, can you hear me?"

" Shin Yoosung, don’t bother the kkoma Dokja too much."

"I didn’t mean to bother him."

A gentle hand stroking my head. Yoo Sangah was looking down at me with her characteristic faint smile.

As I looked at her smile, it occurred to me that Kim Dokja's story did not fully describe her.

Perhaps it was natural.

Kim Dokja's mind is filled with the 'Ways of Survival', and the criteria for judgment are also within the 'Ways of Survival'.

「The look is enough to slap Yoo Joonghyuk three times in the face.」

If we were to apply the standards of 'Ways of Survival', Yoo Sangah was definitely a beautiful woman.

Is it just how she looks? Her warm heart and warm consideration... But haven't I been talking only about Yoo Sangah since a while ago?

[The story fragment 'Kim Dokja who respects Yoo Sangah' continues its storytelling.]

It was somehow strange.

I guess this was the core story that made up 'kkoma Kim Dokja'.

"But doesn't that seem really dangerous?"

Lee Jihye, who was looking at the display screen, said something.

"What if they really die like that?"

On the screen, Ji Eunyu and Cha Yerin were still struggling to drive the carriage. As I was caught up in the shocking situation, I forgot about the people I was supposed to protect.

Now was the time to unlock [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

[A temporary error occurs in this skill.]

[You cannot release 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' level 3.]

Shit. What is it again this time?

I became impatient.

On the screen, we saw enemies attacking the carriage we were riding in. Ji Eunyu and Cha Yerin are strong, but the situation is difficult with just the two of them.

If I don't go right now—

"Do you want me to possess my past self again?"

Lee Gilyoung frowned at Shin Yoosung's question.

"Shin Yoosung, have you already forgotten that you suffered a probability aftermath before?"

"…"

"It would be better if I logged in as a Constellation and used 'Deus Ex Machina'—"

"Don’t be stupid. That’s a place where outside Constellations can’t intervene."

"Then why not just descend directly?"

"Didn’t you hear that descending was prohibited? If you did something like that—"

"The sooty bastard descended."

"That’s because Joonghyuk ahjussi—"

"Why can the sooty bastard do it and I can’t?"

While Yoo Sangah, who was worse off, was trying to stop the two children, Lee Jihye looked at me this time and asked.

"Kkoma, what do you think? Help me with that? Or not? I think I can just secretly go and use [Intant Kill] once."

My heart was beating slowly.

I know it's just words. Because Lee Jihye doesn’t know that I am now possessing this 'kkoma Kim Dokja'.

Still, I had a hard time shaking off the temptation of those words.

「If only I could get help from <Kim Dokja Company>.」

I thought of Ji Eunyu, Cha Yerin, Killer King Cha Sungwoo, Dansu ahjussi, and Kyung Sein's faces one after another.

If we can get help from <Kim Dokja Company>, we may be able to guarantee the safety of the party.

We will no longer have to face death scenarios.

I moved my hand slowly.

I was going to tell Lee Jihye. Please help, please help my companions not die— But at that moment, a light spark struck my head.

「"Why did you want to become a writer?"」

Distorted sentences appeared on Han Sooyoung's dying face.

「If we receive help from Kim Dokja Company here, whose story is it?」

While I was breathing hard and blinking my eyes, Lee Jihye turned her head again and looked at her screen.

「"I'll drive. Can you take care of the carriage behind me?"」

「"I heard Yerin-ssi is a minor."」

「"Yes, but I really wanted to try driving at least once."」

The carriage on the screen accelerated with a roar.

The group watched the accelerating carriage in silence.

「"Then I'll leave it to you for a moment. Yerin, have you ever played a car game?"」

「"I've never tried it, but I think I can try it!"」

「"Okay. Every game has rules, so let's follow them. I'll take care of the carriage that follows, Yerin—"」

Just as the Constellations once watched their story. Just as Kim Dokja read Yoo Joonghyuk's story. <Kim Dokja Company> silently watched our story.

"That person over there somehow looks like Sangah-ssi."

Shin Yoosung said something.

"She's pretty good. It's not as good as ours."

Lee Gilyoung, who seems to be entering puberty, also left a comment. The companions smiled faintly.

Meanwhile, Ji Eunyu blocked the attack of another carriage and overturned two carriages approaching from both sides.

Yoo Sangah nodded her head.

"She’s a good fighter."

"We fought like that too. Do you remember? Back then—"

The carriage ran away. A carriage that is neither Apollo's golden chariot nor Surya's train. Nevertheless, I knew what story my companions were seeing through that carriage.

「I miss you.」

As I listened to the sentence, where I couldn't tell who was thinking, I felt like my heart was breaking for some reason.

<Kim Dokja Company> was located here.

Even after their story was over, they remained here and missed the story. As I read the stories of myself and my companions, I was thinking about one person for a long time.

「I miss you.」

How long did they remember those years before a person's name finally became their life?

Looking up at their faces, for the first time, I lost confidence in what I was about to do.

「I was thinking of changing the ending of the 41st Round.」

What would happen to these people if I changed the fixed world line?

If the ending of the 41st Round is changed, will <Kim Dokja Company>, which was born from that ending, be safe?

Will the probability of this world allow their longing?

"Kim Dokja!"

The group turned around at the same time at the loud, energetic tone.

Yoo Joonghyuk was there.

"Kim Dokja!"

Yoo Joonghyuk was walking around with a serious expression, calling out Kim Dokja's name.

Lee Jihye, who was observing Yoo Joonghyuk, asked.

"You said you fought with Master Odin, right? Did you hit your head wrongly?"

In the end, Yoo Sangah, who was worse off, approached Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Joonghyuk-ssi. What's going on?"

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at Yoo Sangah for a moment, then began to look at the surrounding space with a bewildered look.

About ten seconds like that.

"There was Kim Dokja."

"Yes?"

"No, Kim Dokja has come."

"What do you mean?"

Yoo Joonghyuk said as if he was frustrated.

"It means that 'Kim Dokja' is here now."

"huh? But Dokja-ssi—"

Yoo Sangah, who had been talking up to that point, turned her gaze towards me.

Yoo Sangah's eyes slowly grew bigger.

It was almost at the same time that Yoo Joonghyuk discovered me.

This was the first time I knew [Red Phoenix Shunpo] was that good and fast of a skill. When I came to my senses, I was hanging in the air with Yoo Joonghyuk's hand holding my ankle.

"No, Master! What should I do if I hear you say that!"

"What is this?"

"These are the fragments of ahjussi that I collected. Handle them carefully! They may break!"

Yoo Joonghyuk's harsh eyes glared at me.

I imagined turning off [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] several times in my head.

Yoo Joonghyuk said.

"Kim Dokja."

"Master, that's not him. The real ahjussi is in there right now—"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the screen pointed to by Lee Jihye.

Inside was my figure, stretched out like a squid and bouncing around in a rickety carriage.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked back and forth between me and me on the screen with confused eyes.

"Wait a minute. The guy over there… he's passed out just now, right?"

It was then that Shin Yoosung opened her mouth.

"A skill used every time my ahjussi faints."

"No way—"

One by one, the eyes of my companions turn to me gathered together.

Yoo Joonghyuk, Yoo Sangah, Shin Yoosung, Lee Gilyoung, Lee Seolhwa, and Lee Jihye.

The gathered group looked at each other with nervous eyes.

"Joonghyuk-ssi, are you sure? Did you sense Dokja-ssi's presence?"

"That guy has a unique eerie feeling."

"What do you think, what does the sooty bastard know?"

"Can you feel him here now?"

Yoo Joonghyuk, who held me with his vicious hand, glared at me once again.

And after a while, Yoo Joonghyuk's head moved slightly.

The next moment, an eerie silence swept over the surroundings.

The group members looked at each other's faces and nodded at the same time.

"Let’s lock him up."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 759 Episode 32 Monkey King (6)

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“No, wait!”

I wanted to shout that out to <Kim Dokja Copany>, they were surrounding me with ferocious force.

But I can't make a proper sound with this body.

"Would you like to buy a cage first?"

"Do you want to stay in the Dokkaebi’s Bag?"

"Wouldn’t it be okay to ask Biyoo?"

"Should I get a leash too?"

"What kind of dog is this?"

I overheard the conversation of my companions while clinging to Yoo Joonghyuk's grip. Meanwhile, Yoo Joonghyuk was glaring at me with strange eyes.

[A temporary error occurs in this skill.]

[You cannot release level 3 of 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint'.]

The skill still did not listen. The moment when the fear rises that if I continue like this, I will really be imprisoned and not be able to go anywhere.

"Okay, everyone, stop joking around."

Yoo Sangah, with a gentle smile, held me up and stopped the crowd.

"Huh? You weren't really confining him, were you?"

Lee Seolhwa, who had just brought a cart with iron bars, tilted her head and asked.

Where on earth did she get something like that? No matter how you look at it, it looks like it's being used to confine laboratory animals.

Yoo Sangah shook her head as if she could not stop her.

Lee Gilyoung asked.

"That little guy, he's not understanding what we're saying, is he?"

"He understands."

The other party members noticed Yoo Joonghyuk's answer and surrounded me.

"Ahjussi, is that really you?"

I wanted to answer, but no voice came out.

Shin Yoosung seemed to have noticed something in my appearance.

"I guess he can't speak."

"How about we do it this way? First of all, since you can hear what we're saying, we'll have you answer with your eyes. Every time we ask a question, you blink once if we're right, and blink twice if we're wrong. Little guy, you get it?"

It was a good idea.

"Wow, Jihye. We didn't know you could think like that?"

While Lee Gilyoung, who was instantly caught in a headlock, whined, Yoo Sangah settled the situation.

"Okay, then, shall we all calm down and ask questions? Since Dokja-ssi may be confused, ask questions one at a time. Um, shall we start with Gilyoung?"

Then Lee Gilyoung quickly escaped the headlock and approached. Lee Gilyoung looked at me with suspicious eyes and hesitantly opened his mouth.

"Dokja-hyung... is that you?"

The most important question for them.

Am I 'Kim Dokja' or not?

The depth of silence replaced their curiosity.

I blinked.

"Once… twice… huh? Three times?"

"Are you saying it's true or not?"

"Isn't it true that it can be both right and wrong?"

The group of people who were chatting about Lee Seolhwa's words turned to me, holding their breath.

I blinked as if agreeing with that.

"Once! He blinked once!"

"Are you saying what Seolhwa unnie said is correct?"

"He is a Dokja, but he is not Dokja…"

After pondering for a moment, the group members seemed to accept the meaning of the words in their own way.

"What do you mean? Isn't it hyung?"

"No, he's right…"

"Well, the only guy left like this is still him."

"Guys, calm down. You can't ask questions."

I felt strange. It was unfamiliar to me that there were people who showed such a variety of emotions just with my small reaction.

"Dokja-ssi's condition is strange."

It was then that Lee Seolhwa, who was looking at me, suddenly approached me.

There were faint sparks all around me.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' Lv. 3 is unstable.]

Meanwhile, the status of the story became unstable.

It was natural.

No matter how much [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] it is, it is impossible to cross worldlines.

An event that would never be possible without someone providing me with strong probability.

Perhaps soon [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] will be lifted and I will return to the 41st Round.

"Oh, no, Seolhwa-ssi. Please save him!"

"He's not going to die. He'll probably return to his original world."

"Ahjussi, don't go back, stay with us a little longer. Please. You've only been there a little while."

"Shin Yoosung."

Shin Yoosung did not listen to Yoo Sangah's dissuasion.

Shin Yoosung looked back at the screen and held my hand tightly.

"I know you have a place to go to, and I know those people need you. But, but we also…"

Shin Yoosung, perhaps because her throat was so tight, could not bear to speak.

But she could be heard clearly. Because I was now the 'Demon King of Salvation', and she was my incarnation.

"We need you too."

I wanted to say something.

Can I convey my feelings by blinking my eyes violently?

No, maybe I'm glad that blinking is all I can do.

"Yoo Sangah. Let’s calm down and listen to Dokja-ssi. Seolhwa-ssi, how much time do we have left?"

"It’s five minutes at most."

"Shin Yoosung, is there anything you want to ask Dokja-ssi?"

At those words, everyone took a step back.

Everyone had a question on their face, but they were willing to give up their questions for Shin Yoosung.

Shin Yoosung asked me as if she were understanding the feelings of those people.

"Ahjussi... why did you come here?"

A question I cannot answer.

Yoo Sangah lightly hugged the child's shoulder. On behalf of the trembling Shin Yoosung, Yoo Sangah kindly changed her question.

"Did you miss us by any chance?"

Shin Yoosung, who had lowered her head, looked up at me.

Perhaps that was the real question Shin Yoosung really wanted to ask.

I looked at the face of <Kim Dokja Company>.

「Let’s think that Kim Dokja is here now.」

Shin Yoosung, Lee Gilyoung, Yoo Sangah, Lee Jihye, Lee Seolhwa, Yoo Joonghyuk… And even Han Sooyoung, who is not here.

I wanted to see their faces forever. I wanted to remember.

I blinked slowly, as if taking a picture.

"Ah."

Shin Yoosung's eyes filled with tears. Lee Gilyoung slowly lowered his head, and Lee Jihye turned her head away and muttered something unintelligible. Lee Seolhwa examined me with a light sigh. Yoo Joonghyuk still looked at me with incomprehensible eyes.

Yoo Sangah said with a bitter smile.

"Thank you."

I blinked twice, indicating that I did not deserve to hear such words.

Slowly, Yoo Sangah's face got closer.

When her breath reached my ear, she whispered in a voice that only I could hear.

"I know. Dokja-ssi is not the 'Kim Dokja' we remember."

As expected, Yoo Sangah knew.

"Still, we think Dokja-ssi is Dokja-ssi. No one can deny that."

The person who still calls me 'Kim Dokja' even though I don't even know how much percentage I have left.

Yoo Sangah's face slowly moved away. In a very clear voice she opened her mouth.

"If it's okay with you, Dokja-ssi, you can stay here."

For a moment I thought I heard wrong.

"We will provide the probability. As you can see, we are quite strong. Even so, we are all people who cleared the 'last scenario'."

A stir arose deep within my heart.

"Stay here. We'll do something for the 41st Round."

What would happen if I really stayed here?

As she said, if only we could solve the 41st Round with their help.

"That's right, Dokja-ssi. We can help! All I have to do is possess myself! Lee Gilyoung isn't much help either, but he accessed that place as a Constellation and—"

"If you want, I will go and fight for you."

Their stories spoke to me.

[The story 'Kim Dokja Company' begins its storytelling.]

As the story began, I could clearly feel the white space between the lines supporting the sentences.

The abyss of <Kim Dokja Company> that is never revealed to others.

I once again realized what they had lost to come here.

There were not many members of <Kim Dokja Company> present.

Still, they didn't blame me.

They were just telling me that it would be okay as long as I stayed on the line they made.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' frowns.]

What is so important about writing 'my story'?

What Han Sooyoung said may be wrong. Maybe I'm not qualified to talk about the 41st Round.

Above all, the 41st Round was the officially 'ended' story. No matter how hard I struggle, I cannot change the story.

Maybe staying here would be a better choice than wasting time on such useless things.

To spend the rest of my life serving those who find comfort in my presence—

「"Where is that guy?"」

When I looked up, a video was playing on the screen.

「"Find that guy’s carriage."」

Yoo Joonghyuk was speaking in the 41st Round.

「"If we are to see the end of the 'Recycling Center', we definitely need him."」

If I give up here, what will happen to Yoo Joonghyuk?

"Ahjussi?"

Even while I was here, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st Round was fighting. He was running toward the end of a fleeting story that would ultimately fail.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' grins.]

Seeing Yoo Joonghyuk like that, I finally understood Kim Dokja.

[The synchronization rate with your sponsor increases significantly.]

Kim Dokja, who did not stay in the 1,863rd round was finally convinced of his return to his own world.

"Yes? Ahjussi. Please stay here with me. Will you stay? Yes?"

I looked the child in the eyes. But nothing was seen. Because Shin Yoosung's small hands were covering my eyes.

"No. Don't answer."

The hand that created the pitch-black darkness was trembling. Yoo Joonghyuk's voice was heard beyond the darkness.

"Listen carefully, Kim Dokja."

Yoo Joonghyuk was speaking in a voice that did not show the slightest agitation.

"No matter what story you want, we will make it the ending we want. And you can't stop it."

Yoo Joonghyuk's turned back was seen between the child's fingers.

It is said that he fought with Odin.

Perhaps he was the one who protected the Demon King of Salvation and me beyond the 'Void Curtain'.

"Dokja-ssi."

Tsutsu, the air shook with sparks. The feeling that gently surrounded me was fading away.

[The signal of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' becomes weaker.]

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint is finally about to be released.]

Shin Yoosung burst into tears once again, and Lee Gilyoung turned back. Lee Jihye took a step closer and held onto my arm.

Yoo Sangah said.

"Thank you for coming."

While listening to Yoo Sangah's voice, I thought about Kim Dokja.

"We're okay. So, you, Dokja-ssi, must definitely survive to the end."

But Kim Dokja was not there, and the only thing here was the helpless, blinking agent of the Demon King of Salvation.

The air swirled along with people's voices.

The world of <Kim Dokja Company> was fading away.

I felt confident again.

「Kim Dokja would have wanted to return to his companions more than anyone else.」

Still, why didn't he come here?

Why did he have to leave the people he loved the most?

Then, a voice came from my fading consciousness.

【Do you really want to know?】

I could feel it instinctively.

【Even if the truth could destroy you forever?】

I know the owner of this voice.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 760 Episode 32 Monkey King (7)

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Perhaps even Kim Dokja would not have heard the voice of 'Gods of the Other World' as much as I do now.

While the Constellations' voices felt clear and bold, the 'God of the Other World''s voice was closer to the feeling of hearing a discordant sound.

An infinitely disturbing voice that goes against the system of this world.

But even in this uneasiness, there was a temperature. Some disturbances were hot and damp, while others were cool and harsh.

And the voice I just heard was clearly closer to the latter.

The extreme cold of winter.

A voice coming from the edge of the universe that has reached absolute zero.

Not Asmodeus.

Then who is it?

What's certain is that it's a voice I feel like I've heard before somewhere.

And the person who has this voice is the person who helped me and <Kim Dokja Company> meet.

I wanted to ask.

Even if I am destroyed as you said, I want to know the reason why Kim Dokja did not return.

But my voice still wouldn't come out, and all I could do was blink my eyes as best as I could.

【Then.】

Fortunately, the owner of the voice read the signal.

【Go up to the top floor of the 'Recycling Center'. Because the 'story' you are looking for will be there.】

[Stage 3 of the exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is released.]

---

The two carriages came together on either side with a loud sound.

The sound of carriage wheels scraping.

"Yerin-ssi!"

Cha Yerin pressed the acceleration button, but the opposing carriages were faster.

As the carriages wheeled close together, the three carriages tangled and rattled dangerously.

"Sorry. I'm not good at driving—"

"No. It's not Yerin-ssi's fault."

Clearly, Cha Yerin accelerated properly. The problem was over there.

"That carriage, it looks like a carriage with options."

[Exclusive skill 'Edit Lv.10' is activated.]

When Ji Eunyu's exclusive skill [Edit] was activated, the composition of the carriage's story was revealed at a glance.

[Story fragment 'Major Haste' continues its storytelling.]

[Story fragment 'Courner' continues its storytelling.]

Ji Eunyu frowned.

"Why don’t we have something like that?"

No matter how you look at it, it wasn't an option that was attached from the beginning. If that were the case, the same 'story fragments' would have been detected in the carriage she is riding now.

That means they got that piece from somewhere and put it on.

[The Constellation 'Snake Cutting Its Tail' grins.]

It seemed like there was someone in the Chinese zodiac who used a trick.

I guess they found out about the 'Recycling Center'’s scenario in advance and secretly supported their incarnation.

"Meihouwang! Wake up! Let’s make something like that too!"

But Meihouwang did not wake up from his snoring. The same thing happened to the man next to her.

Meanwhile, the pressure from both sides continued.

"Give me Kim Dokja!"

A voice coming from somewhere. At first, she thought I heard it wrong, but when she listened to it again, she was sure there was no mistake.

"Give me Kim Dokja!"

Ji Eunyu laughed.

"It was like that throughout the main story, and it’s still like that here."

"…"

"Huh? Yerin-ssi, were you laughing just now?"

"No."

The two glanced at the sleeping man's face. He said they would come back in 1 minute, but it felt like 10 minutes had already passed.

But neither of them woke him up. Because they believed that if he didn't wake up, there was a good reason.

The number of carriages following outside the window was increasing.

Three, four, five.

Ji Eunyu hesitated, then took out a dagger from her chest and began to sharpen it.

[You begin cleaning the relic 'Ghost'.]

Cha Yerin, who glanced at Ji Eunyu’s appearance, asked.

"Eunyu-ssi."

"Yes."

"Are you close with the Author?"

"Well, we went through some difficult times together."

"Tough times."

"Yes, tough times."

"Was the author like this when you first met him?"

"If he looks like this…"

"Kim Dokja’s face."

"That’s what I remember."

"So the Author was Kim Dokja from the beginning?"

"Yes?"

"The writer—"

A shout was heard from outside looking for Kim Dokja once again.

Cha Yerin continued speaking after a moment.

"When this story ends, will he return to the world he came from?"

The world he came from.

Ji Eunyu thought for a moment and then answered.

"I’m an editor, so I don’t know much about that, but I know one thing for sure. The world the writer will return to is 'reality'."

"…"

"And the author’s reality."

Ji Eunyu, who had finally finished trimming the dagger, stood up from her seat and looked at Cha Yerin.

"It’s a place where there are readers to read."

[The relic 'Ghost' has been cleaned.]

"Yerin-ssi, I will leave the writer to you for a while. I have to go up to the roof."

"I hope you don’t mind."

"Please drive."

Ji Eunyu quickly jumped out the window and stood on the roof of the carriage. Then, as if they had been waiting, there were incarnations that jumped onto the roof opposite. Judging by the stories flowing around them, they were the incarnations of the 'snake force'.

"Give me Kim Dokja!"

"Our author, you are very popular here."

At someone's command, the incarnations of the side carriages rushed over to the roof.

Ji Eunyu immediately threw the dagger.

The incarnations on the side laughed as they saw the dagger flying through the wind. This is because the trajectory and speed of the flying dagger were ordinary.

[The relic 'Ghost' remembers your sincere care.]

[The first 'Ghost' of the relic 'Ghost' is activated.]

[The cutting power and acceleration of the relic 'Ghost Blade' increases tenfold for 10 minutes!]

Ghost is one of the treasures of <The First Murim>. It was a 'hidden piece' obtained from a meteorite with the support of her sponsor.

The downside is that it can only be used after 'ten cleaning sessions' every day.

However, once the preparation was completed, the monster's attack power for 10 minutes was enough to surpass the famous sword 'Black Heavenly Demon Blade'.

"This is crazy—"

The complexions of the incarnations changed as they sensed that the blade's prowess had changed.

Limbs and limbs being cut off like cutting soft tofu.

As two incarnations fell down in an instant following the blade's path, one of the incarnations on the roof of the rear carriage shouted.

"Kill her quickly!"

The ghost was already moving away along its trajectory.

Five incarnations rushed to Ji Eunyu at the same time, whose weapon had disappeared.

However.

"It’s a waste of space."

"What?"

"Ah, you’re perfect for being edited."

A sound was heard from somewhere, and the legs f two more incarnations flew off. It was a neat work of art, as if cutting out unnecessary sentences from a manuscript.

"Kaaaaaaak!"

The ghost, who was thought to have followed the trajectory and gone away, was soon back in Ji Eunyu's hands.

Translucent spider art ran along the tip of the dagger.

Belatedly, the incarnation also realized what was happening.

"No way is that—"

[The exclusive skill 'Arachne's Web' is in effect.]

The Holy Spirit of <Olympus>, [Arachne's Web].

Originally, this holy spirit could not be used unless it was a terminal incarnation of <Olympus>, but she was the exception.

This was possible because <Olympus> was destroyed in the world line of her sponsor.

[Some Constellations are surprised to see your skills!]

Incarnations were buzzing from the carriages that followed at the rear.

"Who is that person? Could it be that she is an incarnation of <Olympus>?"

"That can't be true. The use of stigmata must be restricted."

"If you touch her by mistake—"

"The bounty amount is high. I can't miss this opportunity."

As she listened to the story, it was clear how the situation was going.

It seems that someone with a vengeance in the middle of the Chinese Zodiac had put up a bounty scenario on this side.

Ji Eunyu smiled and continued.

"If you touch me, the entire <Olympus> will attack. Are you prepared?"

At first glance, she thought it was a good thing because there were so many carriages. If she can take advantage of this misunderstanding, without unnecessary fights—

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'.]

[Someone confirmed that the statement is not true.]

Ji Eunyu let out a light sigh.

"As expected. There is no way this novel will proceed easily."

"Hit her! All we have to do is deal with the guy in the carriage!"

Ji Eunyu deflected the incoming weapons with [Arachne's Web].

But no matter how strong she was, it was difficult for her to handle multiple attacks.

"Yerin-ssi! Run!"

Perhaps because of the fundamental difference in the performance of the carriages, no matter how much they drove, their carriages did not get far away.

It was then that one side of the spider web broke.

"Now!"

In the blink of an eye, a round object pierced through the carriage window.

[The Constellation 'Snake Cutting Its Tail' awaits your destruction.]

Ji Eunyu immediately recognized what the item was.

'Mass destruction magical bullet.'

It was the exact item used by Han Sooyoung in the main story.

Ji Eunyu shouted, swearing inwardly.

"Yerin-ssi! Author!"

But the explosion was faster. The carriage flew apart with a loud noise, and Ji Eunyu was swept away by the explosion.

[The 'Orient Express' was destroyed.]

Her consciousness flickered with a despairing message.

The moment her body, soaring high in the sky, fell violently toward the floor, Ji Eunyu felt the wind blowing from somewhere.

Someone was holding her with both hands.

The man's face was reflected in a dazzling halo, and Ji Eunyu’s breath was taken away. Because that face resembled someone she had imagined for a long time.

"Kim Dokja?"

Then the man answered.

"Of course. That’s my name."

Ji Eunyu answered.

"Liar?..."

The man nodded his head.

"It’s my job to lie. You can pass out now."

Ji Eunyu was relieved and closed her eyes.

---

I landed on the floor, carrying the unconscious Ji Eunyu on my back.

I roughly guessed and understood the situation.

Did she use ‘that weapon’?

It's an item that only has settings and has never been used in the main story, but it looks like she managed to get it.

[The target is currently in a 'vulnerable to fainting' state.]

The strangeness also imposes status abnormalities on the user depending on the strangeness that occurs.

It seems that her current status abnormality is 'vulnerable to fainting'.

I looked at Ji Eunyu’s fainted expression for a moment. Although she had Min Jiwoon's face, her visible fatigue was clearly that of Ji Eunyu that I knew.

She was like this when she stayed in the editing room all night editing a book. Maybe she hasn't been able to sleep a wink since she possessed a character.

Even if there is a 'vulnerability to fainting' penalty, she is not the kind of person who will faint like this.

"Author."

Cha Yerin landed with the rising wind. As expected, she who possessed the [Way of the Wind] appears to have been unharmed even in the explosion.

"What happened to them?"

"We took care of a few people, but the rest all ran away."

Since our carriage was broken anyway, I guess they thought their goal was achieved.

It could have been so. In this scenario, without a carriage, you are as good as dead.

"I'm sorry. I—"

"No, you did well."

"Are the other party members okay?"

I hesitated for a moment and then answered.

"They're safe."

Would Cha Yerin believe me if I told her that I came after watching with <Kim Dokja Company>?

Would Cha Yerin be upset if the meaning of 'party' became unfamiliar to me just because I met them in such a short period of time?

I shook my head lightly and promised.

"We will make them safe."

My group is over here now. And these are the people I must protect.

"What should we do? We lost the carriage—"

"It's okay. It's just as it was originally planned."

Kim Dokja in the main story also said, 'I fell from a carriage on the way to the Constellation banquet. This was expected from the beginning.

[You have lost the 'Orient Express'.]

[A new event has occurred!]

For reference, Kim Dokja, who fell from the carriage, was chased by the gods of the nebulae.

[You are no longer protected by the 'Orient Express Wagon'.]

[The gods near the cloud road notice your presence!]

Damn it, it seemed like a similar event was happening here too.

['Edge of the Other World' opens.]

I don't know the origin, but I know it's ominous just by hearing the name.

In the main story, Kim Dokja had 'Dionysus' to protect him. But there is no Dionysus here.

"Let’s run away."

We activated [Way of the Wind] with all our might without even looking back.

[Warning. Your ranking is 'bottom'.]

[You are a representative of 'Zone 13'.]

[If you do not arrive at your destination in time, your entire group will die.]

If I activate [Way of the Wind] with all my might, I can reach the destination faster than a carriage.

The problem is that the distance is too far.

In this state, our magical energy will run out before we reach our destination.

And when our magic power runs out, gods crawling out of the corners of the other world or something will come to kill us.

There was only one choice.

"It’s them, right?"

I rode with [Way of the Wind] and landed on the roof of the carriage that was running ahead.

[Story fragment 'Facial Recognition' recognizes you.]

[You are not the correct passenger in that carriage…]

I tore off the entire roof of the carriage, down to the story fragments. Then the incarnation of the snake force that discovered me widened its eyes in astonishment.

"You—"

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' reveals his status.]

"Ugh, uhhh—"

The guys just sat down in contemplation just by expressing their anger.

I picked them up one by one and threw them outside, then sat down with Cha Yerin.

[You have captured the 'Orient Express Wagon'.]

[Story fragment 'Facial Recognition' interrupts its storytelling.]

['Orient Express Carriage' recognizes you as a new passenger.]

['Controller' will be provided.]

I grabbed the controller. Even though the roof flew off, it is a model with a story option, so the speed should be quite respectable.

The problem is control.

"I’ll do it. I heard you’re not good at games."

Cha Yerin held out her hand.

"Did Ji Eunyu say something like that? It’s not like I can’t do it—"

To be honest, it's average.

Still, I have to take the wheel this time.

"But this time, I will do it. I am now the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

"Kim Dokja is not good at games either."

Right. Kim Dokja may be worse at games than me.

"But I’m good at imitating guys who are good at games."

[The exclusive skill 'Bookmark' is activated!]

['Bookmark List' is activated.]

[Currently, due to a temporary error, the 'Bookmark List' cannot be activated.]

Is it because the story of the 'Demon King of Salvation' has not been completely inherited? Unfortunately, the original 'characters' that the Demon King of Salvation knew were not included in the list.

However, this does not mean that there are no 'persons who can be registered'.

**<List of people currently available for bookmarking>**

1. Kim Cheolyang, the leader of the Life Cult (Comprehension 25)

2. Action leader Bang Cheolsoo (Comprehension level 30)

3. Immortal King Lee Dansu (Comprehension 55)

4. Kang Ilhoon who wants to be Yoo Joonghyuk (Comprehension level 65)

…

All the 'people' I had met so far were in that bookmark.

I flipped through the list again and again, like I was flipping through my brief history.

7. Judge of Destruction Jung Heewon (Comprehension 50)

8. Strategist Ye Hyunwoo (Comprehension 20)

9. Assassin Gu Seonah (Comprehension 10)

10. Bald King Gong Pildu (Comprehension 15)

11. Master Jung Moonho (Comprehension level 35)

12. Magician Martinez (Comprehension 5)

13. Hypnotist Christina (Comprehension 20)

But no matter how many times I flipped through it, I couldn't find the name I wanted.

14. Lord of Salvation Nirvana (Comprehension 3)

15. Prophetess Anna Croft (Comprehension 15)

"Author."

Cha Yerin looked in my direction.

I continued to flip through the list of characters.

Surely it exists?

「Did I not understand 'Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st Round' at all?」

Maybe so. This 'bookmark' will only show characters that I have a little understanding of.

I boasted that I would write this guy's story, but the truth is, I don't really know what kind of person he is.

[This is the last page.]

Finally, the last page of the character list.

As expected, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round was not registered in the bookmarks.

Instead,

25. Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk (Comprehension level 1)

There was a strange Yoo Joonghyuk.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 761 Episode 32 Monkey King (8)

Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk?

I absentmindedly looked at the list of characters in the bookmarks. There was a memory that slowly emerged.

「"I am neither employed nor unemployed."」

Somehow, I felt like I knew what kind of Yoo Joonghyuk this 'Yoo Joonghyuk' was.

Then I didn't have to hesitate.

[The character 'Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk' has been registered to bookmark number 1.]

I don’t know what kind of 'unemployed' that 'unemployed' refers to—

"I will activate bookmark number 1, 'Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk'."

Because no unemployed person in this world is better at playing games than him.

"What did you just say?"

"Please pretend you didn’t hear it."

In response to Cha Yerin’s question, I shrugged my shoulders and looked ahead.

[Activation time is determined in proportion to the level of the bookmark skill.]

[Your understanding of the character is very low.]

[The activation time of the Bookmark skill is partially corrected depending on your exclusive characteristics.]

[Activation time: 10 minutes]

…

[Your physical composition is different from that of the character.]

[Warning! The status of this character is abnormally high!]

[The level of the activated skill is forcibly adjusted.]

[You cannot choose which skills are activated.]

Unfortunately, it was not possible to select the skill to be activated. However, according to my opinion, the skill activated by [Bookmark] is the main skill of the relevant 'character'.

If the target had been 'King Yoo Joonghyuk', [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] would have been activated, but who I understood was 'Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk'.

If I remember correctly, Yoo Joonghyuk did not only train the 'sword' throughout his period of unemployed life. therefore-

[Exclusive skill 'Sky View Lv.10' has been activated.]

[You will be able to see the stars in the sky more clearly than anyone else.]

I looked at the message with a devastated face.

Is this for real?

"The speed is dropping."

"I know. Don’t worry."

I never thought I would develop a skill like this.

Cannot help it. This time, I have no choice but to take the next best option.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite' Lv.10 is activated.]

"I am 'Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk' who is good at games."

Cha Yerin looked at me like she was looking at Killer King. I ignored her gaze and focused on the effects of the skill.

「Incite could not activate specific skills as precisely as bookmark.」

However, the special advantage of this skill is that it can imitate the 'characteristics' of the person in question, albeit slightly.

「Understanding of the exclusive skill 'Bookmark' affects the activation of 'Incite'.」

[Bookmark number 1: Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk's attribute is activated.]

I also have a conscience.

I don't even want to be the 'ruler of entertainment'. So please—

[Exclusive attribute 'Pro Gamer' is activated.]

Yes. This is it!

[All types of 'gaming skills' are greatly improved due to the effects of exclusive characteristics.]

Suddenly the view became clear.

I could see at a glance where to run on the terrain. Cornering here. Go straight here. It's surprising. Is this the perspective of 'Pro Gamer Yoo Joonghyuk'?

[Exclusive attribute discovers hidden pieces of the stage.]

[The stage's 'acceleration zone' has been discovered.]

As we entered the acceleration zone at the correct timing, the carriage began to run at an unbelievable speed. It was almost questionable whether it was the same carriage.

Cha Yerin also opened her mouth as she watched the scenery passing by quickly.

Soon, the line of carriages ahead began to appear.

Our group was also at the rear of the line.

"Kim Dokja!"

Killer King and Yoo Joonghyuk's carriage.

"Dokja-ssi! Here we are! Come quickly!"

And even the carriage of Dansu ahjussi and Kyung Sein next to them.

I managed to breathe a sigh of relief. If this continues, we can at least avoid last place.

Just go a little further. A little bit more-

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Sheep' is worried about your safety!]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' warns you to run away quickly!]

It was then that a strange message was heard from the air.

[The Constellation 'Rat that brings plague' is opening their eyes!]

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' is greatly surprised!]

[The Constellation 'Liverless rabbit' gnaws at the spot where the liver used to be!]

[A significant number of Constellations doubt the probability of the incident.]

[A few Constellations feel fear.]

I had an ominous feeling. Are the Constellations expressing 'fear'?

Tsutsutsu.

Faint sparks flew from my arm as I adjusted the controller.

The aftereffects of the probability aftermath.

Why did probability suddenly become like this? Because I called 'Unemployed Yoo Joonghyuk' as [Bookmark]? Or not-

[Someone violated an important probability of the <Star Stream>.]

I felt like my heart was sinking.

[The <Star Stream> detects your story.]

[You temporarily experienced another world line.]

[You have not completed the 'Returnee Scenario'.]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is moving.]

[The Edge of the Other World will be expanded for 10 minutes from now.]

Lightning struck from the sky, and the carriages running behind were destroyed with a loud noise.

Something was chasing us through the thick clouds of dust.

"Ah."

There was a faint fear in Cha Yerin's voice. It was not difficult to realize the source of the fear.

At the back of the carriage, visible through a cloud of pitch-black dust, were seven-tailed dogs. A fear that seems to freeze your soul just by looking into your eyes.

['The Hound of the Abyss' has found you.]

A hound chasing the abyss.

Sentinels who kill 'Outer Gods' who harm the balance of the world line and destroy probability.

The hounds were chasing me this time. The reason was obvious.

「Because I came to meet <Kim Dokja Company>.」

I bit my lip and confessed the truth.

"I'm sorry. I guess it's because of me."

"Why the Author—"

"I'll give you a detailed explanation later."

I held on to the controller with all my might and somehow continued to accelerate.

But it was useless. It was not a problem that could be overcome simply through the power of characteristics. The distance between me and the dogs was rapidly shrinking.

If things continue like this, we will be caught quickly.

"Yerin-ssi."

Even if I handed over the controller to Cha Yerin, I had to stop the dogs.

[Your exclusive characteristics are activated.]

In my head, I thought about how to deal with the 'Hounds Chasing the Abyss'.

However, neither the 'Ways of Survival' nor the 'Omniscient Reader' contained any instructions on how to deal with those hunting dogs.

It was natural.

Even Yoo Joonghyuk, who had reached the end of the scenarios, was reluctant because those dogs were unfathomably strong .

Of course, the number was not as large as it was then. Five or six at most.

But for me now, it was difficult to deal with even that one dog.

"I guess I'll do it myself—"

At that moment, a dog ran to the point and jumped onto the roof of the carriage. The moment I made eye contact with the hunting dog, I realized.

I can't deal with this.

This 'Hound' was not a being but a 'phenomenon'. For example, something like the 'Indescribable Distance' that is a disaster.

No matter what I do with my current level of power, I can't resist these guys' pursuit.

[I was wondering why it was suddenly noisy.]

The charging hound flew away with a fierce spark.

I reflexively looked back.

[I told you to wake me up when you arrived at the destination, but you just left me.]

A golden monkey was standing on the torn-off roof of the carriage with a bored expression on his face.

"Meihouwang!"

Meihouwang took out something that looked like a toothpick from his ear and blew on it, revealing his main sacred relic.

The Ruyi Jingu Bang?

No. There was something different about that. A relic that has the same shape as the Ruyi Jingu Bang of Great Sage Heaven's Equal, but has a 'different name'.

Just as the sword 'Amanomurakumono no Tsurugi' made from the tail of 'Yamata no Orochi' was divided into 'different swords' according to the number in its name, the same was true for Sun Wukong's Ruyi Jingu Bang.

[This guy, did you recognize Shin Jincheol, the King of the World?]

His Majesty Jeongjeo Shin Jincheol.

That was the original name of Ruyi Jingu Bang.

A tool used to measure the depth of rivers and seas around the world.

The 'Sea Pendulum' was stored in the warehouse of Ogwang, the Dragon King of the East Sea.

Meihouwang, waving his sacred artifact, spoke.

[I don't know why the dogs of this world are chasing you, but—]

His gaze rested on Ji Eunyu, who had collapsed in the carriage, for a moment.

[Please take care of that child.]

Meihouwang floated in the air, his golden fur fluttering. The moment his new form passed me, I got goosebumps.

He shouted as he faced the stars of the Chinese Zodiac.

[You foolish unemployed people.]

As far as I know, there is no official head in the Zodiac. This is because no one claimed to be the 'head'.

[These hounds are also just 'dogs'. It means that they are beasts like you. What are you so scared of?]

But I knew it the moment I saw him.

[All the Constellations of the Chinese Zodiac are shaking.]

The reason why there was no official head in the <Zodiac> was because everyone in the <Zodiac> implicitly agreed on who their 'head' was.

[The scale of the sea.]

He is the king of all beasts.

[I let go of your true self.]

A heavenly villain that no one in <Emperor> dared to deal with.

The Monkey King of Huagu Mountain.

[The scale of probability moves.]

Meihouwang, who had raised his level to the point where he could take on the 'Hound Chasing the Abyss', roared into the air.

Shin Jincheol, whose size increased in an instant, grew to over hundreds, thousands, and several kilometers. It no longer looked like a rod at all.

Is it because Shin Jincheol’s size was increasing in real time? The hunting dogs were already pushed far away.

[Good. I can't take too long.]

A faint spark was flowing from Meihouwang's whole body.

[Damn, if I didn’t give Jecheon that hair, it would be like this…]

I nodded and immediately started accelerating.

Meihouwang is a legendary Constellation. But because of how vicious the hunting dogs are, they will not die easily here.

I ran the carriage again and again. I had to use the little time that Meihouwang gave me wisely.

How long did it run like that?

Smoke rose from the wheels of the carriage and the wheels stopped.

Now the destination is just around the corner. A huge fortress was visible in the distance.

Cha Yerin and I exchanged glances and then started running with Ji Eunyu on our backs.

And soon we arrived at the entrance of the fort.

[You have arrived at your 'destination'.]

It's a success. It's not too late.

Fortunately, at the entrance, Yoo Joonghyuk, Killer King, Dansu ahjussi, and Kyung Sein were all present.

They were waiting for me.

"You've arrived."

I nodded and walked past them. The distant explosions were getting closer.

If we didn't get inside quickly, we couldn't guarantee that it would be safe until then.

Guarding the entrance was a low-level Dokkaebi who served as the gatekeeper.

[Prove your entry qualifications.]

"I am 'Kim Dokja' from Zone 13. Let my forces in."

But the dokkaebi just frowned as if it was annoying.

[The incarnation you are carrying is allowed to enter.]

I glanced back at Ji Eunyu, who I was carrying. She was still unconscious.

[She belongs to the 'Monkey Faction'. But you are not affiliated with any faction. Prove your affiliation.]

"I would have said I was from Zone 13."

[I haven’t heard of incarnations from Zone 13 coming up—]

As I slowly raised my status, the expression of the low-level Dokkabi changed as it sensed the energy of a Constellation in me.

[So, are you a Constellation? However, 'Zone 13' is not an official force. If you would like to enter—]

The low-level Dokkaebi hesitated for a moment and then said:

[Please name the 'force' you belong to.]

I looked back at my companions.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who turned his back as if he didn't care about the name, stood at the back of the group.

"There is no time, so decide quickly."

I watched Killer King, Literature Girl 64, Lee Dansu, and Kyung Sein while being grateful for their consideration.

And then I thought about their real names.

Cha Sungwoo, Cha Yerin, Noh Kyunghwan, Sung Minwoo.

Maybe we would have thought of the same name at that moment. The only name that binds us who wrote, read, and lived that long story.

My companions nodded and I opened my mouth.

"『Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint』."

The door to the fortress slowly opened.

[You have reached the upper level of the 'Recycling Center'.]

Constellations were waiting for us.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 762 Episode 33 Ball (1)

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「"Have you ever wondered why stars shine so brightly?"
—Mass Production Maker」

A hand holding a pen appeared in the empty void. The hand hesitated for a moment and wrote invisible black letters in the void of space.

【The hunting dogs have moved.】

Infinitely black text that seems to have sucked in the surrounding light.

The hand wrote once again.

【Because of what you did, 'Recorders' from all over the world began to pay attention to this world.】

Then another hand appeared in the void of space. It was a white and long hand. The hand also held a pen and wrote.

【We committed this together.】

【That···.】

【Didn’t you help too, Bicheonhori? Aren’t you also curious about the 'next' story? Isn’t that what made 'him' meet the universe of <Kim Dokja Company>?】

Bicheonhori did not reply.

His hands seemed to be shaking with excitement, and sometimes with fear.

After a while the real hand began writing again.

【The 'first and last record' will begin again. You probably know what that means.】

The long white hand was silent for a moment.

In the distant universe, ignorant stars that could neither read nor reveal the letters twinkled.

【So aren’t you more curious?】

The owner of the long hand wrote as if the ignorance was enjoyable.

【Who will be the 'Recorder' who will write the last sentence of this universe?】

---

[The presence of the hunting dog disappears.]

I was worried, but I was very fortunate.

'Hound' is also 'God from Another World'. Could it be that they can't chase me to the unauthorized core scenario area?

"I lived."

"It really wasn’t easy this time."

As I opened the door to the fortress and entered, joking with my companions, what appeared was a long hallway.

Pictures decorated with colorful frames were hanging on the walls of the hallway.

"Wow, it’s moving?"

When I looked closely, I saw that they were all paintings made from fragments of stories.

A tiger yawning while eating rice cake. A pig building a brick house. A rabbit protecting its liver. The rat that won first place in a running competition. These were all animals from the famous Chinese Zodiac.

At that time, Dansu ahjussi discovered a strange picture.

"There’s also a 'turtle' here."

"Isn’t turtle a not a part of the Chinese zodiac?"

Then Yoo Joonghyuk answered.

"The Chinese Zodiac comes from the 12 letters used in the Chinese calendar. The Chinese Zodiac you know was not the Chinese Zodiac from the beginning."

"Do you know anything about that?"

"It’s common sense."

Indeed, it seems that if you regress about 41 times, you will receive that much common sense.

I suddenly became curious and asked.

"Have you ever been here?"

"This is my first time."

So close.

I thought that Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st Round might also know about this place, but isn't the 'Zodiac Ball' an event that is easily held?

"This is the first time that an event of this magnitude, such as <Zodiac>, has been held."

"Isn’t that saying too much disregard for the Chinese zodiac?"

Yoo Joonghyuk, who frowned slightly at my words, answered while looking at the end of the distant hallway.

"My goal is the end of all scenarios ."

At that declaration, the group of people walking behind each nodded their heads or secretly looked in my direction and raised their thumbs.

The end of every scenario.

It was absurd to talk about such a goal in only the 41st round, but even so, something was different about this '41st Round'.

It wasn't just because I and the readers were there.

「Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round is special.」

The only history that Yoo Joonghyuk here shares with Yoo Joonghyuk in the main story is from Round 0 to Round 1.

The timeline from the 2nd to the 41st was completely divided. Now, Yoo Joonghyuk of that story has endured dozens of rounds of life that no one knows about.

And he was so devastated that he gave up on the next round after only the 41st Round.

The meaning of despair was clear.

「He was in more despair than Yoo Joonghyuk from any other world line right before he gave up.」

So, if I can just calm him down so he doesn't despair...

"You look in a bad mood."

"It’s just my natural expression."

"You don’t know much about Kim Dokja. He always has that kind of face."

As I opened the door to the banquet hall while listening to Killer King's trivial comments, the huge hall came into view at a glance.

The hall was divided into a stage on the first floor and an auditorium on the second floor with thin curtains.

Because the banquet hall was so noisy, our appearance didn't really go noticed. Rather, it was fortunate.

[Oh, you’re finally here.]

A light noise was heard in the air, and Bihyung appeared.

"Your appearance has changed."

[It’s become cool, right?]

Bihyung's body had grown significantly compared to before, as he had just become a mid-level Dokkaebi. Just looking at it, it looked like he had gained weight.

Bihyung must have thought something when he saw my expression, so he tapped my shoulder and whispered.

[Hey, don't be too intimidated. You know that the Constellations gathered here are all in the process of developing a scenario, right? There is no one particularly different from you.]

I don't know why he suddenly said such a thing, but I nodded and answered.

"I know."

[How cocky. Come on, Incarnations, go over there. Reiki will guide you.]

[I will guide you!]

Dokkaebi Reiki. Even when Kim Dokja went to the 'Constellation Banquet', that Dokkaebi guided the way.

[For those of you who are incarnations, please follow me here—]

[You idiot. That's the Dokkaebis' waiting room.]

[Sorry. Back here...!]

He was quite immature for a Dokkaebi, and he seemed similar in this round as well.

Bihyung added as if making excuses.

[He's still a trainee Dokkaebi. Even though he looks like that, he is a good guy at heart —]

"I know. Rather, it seems like there is a separate waiting room for the incarnations for this ball."

[That's right. Have you noticed it already? There will be an opportunity to meet with the incarnations again later. Now, come this way.]

"I’m an incarnation too?"

The moment I saw Bihyung's expression, I belatedly understood why he was targeting other Constellations.

[First of all, you are an acting Constellation. Don’t talk nonsense, just follow me.]

As my companions were walking away, they looked towards me with worried expressions, so I gave them a quick glance to show that I was okay.

I was equally worried about them. Because I don't know what kind of guys there will be in the incarnations' waiting room.

Still, I wasn't too worried. Does it matter who is there? There's Yoo Joonghyuk here.

And if I was right, our colleagues who chose other 'forces' would also be in the waiting room. Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, Jung Heewon, maybe even Shin Yoosung. If you think about it, it was a solid lineup.

I followed Bihyung and organized the log of messages that had come in.

[The sub-scenario 'Orient Express Carriage' has ended.]

[You can obtain rewards from previous scenarios.]

[A new main scenario will begin soon.]

The new main scenario will probably be 'Zodiac Ball'.

We'll have to take a closer look at what exactly the task will be...

[Sit over there. It's your seat.]

On the seat of the table in the corner, there was a nameplate with my Constellation modifier written on it.

<Demon King of Salvation (Agent)>

Anyone can see that this is a temporary transfer position.

As I was looking at the empty seat next to me, I heard Bihyung mumbling as he received an urgent call.

[Oh, damn it. What else… Hey, stay here and wait. I'll start explaining the scenario soon. Ah, here I go. Song-]

When I turned my head, Bihyung had disappeared somewhere.

Is this what it feels like when I transfer to a new school and the teacher who introduced me disappears?

I sat at the table and looked at the symbols of other Constellations. There were Constellations glancing in this direction, and there were also Constellations busy talking among themselves.

The composition of the banquet hall itself was not much different from that of the 'Constellations Banquet'.

What can be seen in the hall on the first floor are mainly historical-grade Constellations in the form of symbols. Most of them were not easy to recognize just by looking at their appearance.

I started by looking at those who used relatively easy symbolism.

Of course, the huge rice cake over there must be the Tiger Eating Rice Cakes (the rice cake was torn off in several places, as if he had been seriously injured in the confrontation with me), and is the swollen liver the 'liverless rabbit'? A cut off rattlesnake's tail is the 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail'.

Meanwhile, I also saw a familiar face.

On the left table, the fingernails that had been scratching the table were creeping towards me.

Rat eating fingernails.

There was a reader there who went against the words of the Chinese Zodiac and came to give us advice. However, he hesitated as if he was watching the other Constellations, and then sat down again.

What stopped him was the ugly symbol of the 'bird beak mask'.

What is that mask?

[He is a 'disease-bringing drunk'.]

A calming voice was heard from behind.

[It is said that in the Middle Ages, when there were epidemics, doctors wore masks like that to provide medical treatment.]

When I turned my head in admiration for his knowledge, a pure white line was fluttering there.

The moment I saw the golden dragon engraved on the top of the serenity, I realized who he was.

"Nice to meet you, Waryong."

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' is very pleased with your answer.]

A lying dragon.

He was the famous Dragon King of the Three Kingdoms, Zhuge Gongming.

[Hehe. It's an honor for you to recognize me.]

"Are you also a participant in this scenario?"

The nickname for the lying dragon is Waryong. Since he also has the nickname 'dragon', I thought he might be eligible to participate in this ball.

But Waryong shook his head and laughed.

[I participated as an evaluator for this scenario. Originally I refused, but they asked me again and again... As you know, I am weak at three and a half.]

Try hard and hard. Come to think of it, Zhuge Gongming had such a secret story.

It seems that the 'Recycling Center' made quite an effort to bring Waryong as an evaluator.

[For now, I think things went well. Thanks to coming here, I became your fan.]

You're a fan?

It was an embarrassing expression.

[It's not just me. In fact, among the Constellations invited to judge together, there is a passionate fan of yours... Unfortunately, they cannot come down to the first floor due to

their high status.]

"You mean 'the one who brought ten lambs'?"

[Hehe, you already know.]

I looked up at the second floor auditorium.

Considering the time of the 'Constellation's Banquet', the second floor would naturally contain higher-ranking Constellations than the first floor.

Among them, there must be a Constellation that cheered me on.

As I thought about it, a little confusion came over me.

The fact that the location of the ninth scenario is here means that it is ultimately here with the Constellations.

This means that we will compete with each other,

[The 'Recycling Center Director' chose the stage for the scenario.]

[The Bureau reviews the difficulty level of the scenario.]

No, they wouldn't tell us to gather all the Constellations and make them fight in only the ninth scenario.

Probability would also be insufficient.

[Huh.]

It was then that a bright light came into the center of the hall. She appeared on stage as a young woman with a cute appearance and wearing a rich gothic dress.

[Hi everyone? Today’s host is me! It’s 'Euprosyne'!]

The moment I wondered why on earth that Constellation was here, a feeling of déjà vu shook my mind. Clearly, that Constellation was present at the banquet hall where Kim Dokja attended.

「Euprosyne, the goddess of joy and festivals.」

It was a moment when the 'Zodiac Ball', a banquet for great Constellations, suddenly turned into a gourmet association party hall.

[Thank you everyone for attending despite your busy schedule! Well, even if you are busy, you should all come. Isn't it? This is where the hottest stories in the <Star Stream> appear these days.]

At those words, light laughter flowed from beyond the curtain. On the other hand, no one laughed in the first floor hall.

[We would also like to express our sincere gratitude to the owner of the Recycling Center, the 'Recycling Center Director', who lent us the stage!]

As the head of the recycling center blinked the colorful stage lights in response, Euphrosyne grinned.

[Everyone knows where today’s main event is, right?]

In response to Euphrosyne's words, someone in the audience on the second floor muttered, "Zodiac ball."

[That's right, it's the 'Zodiac Ball' held at the request of the Constellations of the Chinese zodiac!]

Originally, a 'ball' meant a social gathering place where many people gathered and danced. However, the Constellations on the first floor all looked stiff. It didn't seem like they particularly wanted to dance.

[Ah, our Zodiac Constellations, you must have worked so hard to come to the 'Recycling Center'. In the upper scenarios, you were hit by giant nebulae, and in the lower scenarios, you were ignored by the incarnations, and you had nowhere to go, right?]

The blatant ridicule heard from everywhere. Several of the Constellations of the Chinese zodiac were seen trembling slightly.

[How difficult must have been the lives of the Constellations of the Zodiac as our trusted 'Monkey King' silently watched the situation unfold!]

Despite the teasing remarks, the Constellations on the first floor could not even say a word in response.

It was natural.

Because the Constellation on that stage was a 'narrative-grade Constellation' that could not be defeated even if all of them fought against her.

[So, we at the 'Gourmet Association' thought. How about we help the <Zodiac>?]

As I listened to the endless laughter beyond the curtain, I was gradually realizing who this 'Zodiac Ball' was a 'social gathering place' for.

[What if we give those poor, pitiful stars another chance to leap forward? But can the mere grabbing of animals become an interesting 'story'?]

Until now, there has been no mention in any page of 'Ways of Survival' that the 'Zodiac Ball' was conducted in this way.

Why did such a variable arise in this round?

The question didn't last long.

[But there is someone here who answered our questions.]

For a moment, the eyes of the Constellations were focused on me.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 763 Episode 33 Ball (2)

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[You all know who I’m talking about, right? 'Gourmet Association' people especially.]

The concentration of attention was burdensome.

Light laughter was heard from the second floor. It seemed like someone was muttering, "Is that Kim Dokja?"

[The Constellations of the 'Gourmet Association' are looking at you.]

Monsters on a different level from the Historical-grade were sitting there. Each and every one of them calls themselves the winners of the whole world.

Cold sweat formed on my neck and I slowly began to feel suffocated.

Kim Dokja has been fighting against such monsters until now.

I pursed my lips and raised my hand toward them. It was because I thought that if I got discouraged here, I wouldn't be able to face the others later.

I was the one who brought them on this stage in the first place.

I created a story by changing the 'animal tales' of Zone 13, and distributed the stories to the Gourmet Association through Bihyung.

The fact that they came this far means that they fell for the bait I spread.

[Your story is becoming known in the <Star Stream>.]

[15,000 coins were obtained.]

Messages heard in real time.

It was proof that our stories were being steadily consumed in the <Star Stream>.

If so, great. Spend as much as you want. I will feed you stories until your stomach explodes and you die.

[The Constellations of the 'Gourmet Association' welcome you!]

It felt like blood was flowing from my lips that had been so tightly pressed. The moment when it became difficult to bear the gaze of the Constellations.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' restrains the Constellations belonging to the Gourmet Association.]

As soon as I received the message, the pressure that had been weighing me down seemed to have disappeared.

I barely breathed a sigh of relief and nodded lightly toward the evaluator behind the curtain.

However, despite the evaluator's restraint, there were still Constellations looking at me.

The Constellations of the <Zodiac> on the first floor were like that.

It wasn't a threatening gaze like the Constellations on the second floor, but I could feel resentment in their gaze for some unknown reason.

Euphrosyne spoke again.

[Anyway, thanks to you, we found out. Old stories can be just as fun! Just because the generation is older doesn’t mean the <Star Stream> has lost its usefulness!]

To summarize, is it true that I designed the scenario stage inspired by the 'animal stories' that I changed?

For some reason, I didn't have a good feeling.

[In this scenario, you will see a reenactment of an old tale!]

A reenactment of an old tale.

Since this is the <Zodiac Ball>, the background of the dance was likely to be famous animal tales, including the 'Zodiac Race'.

However, the variable was that the

'Gourmet Association' directly intervened.

Since there are many stubborn Constellations in the Gourmet Association, there was a possibility that something like the 'Bracelet Expedition', which was the stage of the Gourmet Association in the main story, could be recreated.

[Wow, everyone’s faces are full of concern. Do not worry. I didn't come with that much old-fashioned stories. What fun would it be to try something like the 'Zodiac Race' again?]

It isn’t the zodiac race?

So is it really the Bracelet Expedition?

[For those who like 11th generation stories, please bear with me this time. Now, shouldn’t the Gourmet Association also need to reform its image? It can't be called a gathering of Constellations that only eat weird food forever, right?]

I don't think it's the Bracelet Expedition either.

So what on earth is it?

[Ahaha, everyone is very worried. Rest assured. To design the stage for this scenario, I received help from the 'Management Bureau' Dokkaebis!]

Euphrosyne waved her hand lightly into the air. Although I can't see it, there are probably Dokkaebis from the Management Bureau, including Bihyung, there.

Some whispers were heard from the zodiac signs:

[The Administration intervened? Only in the ninth scenario?]

[Probably not. The fact that the management bureau moved even before the scenario started...]

Euphrosyne seemed to have heard them and nodded.

[Right! There is no way such a big event could happen in only the ninth scenario. You're smart.]

The ominous premonition was gradually becoming a reality.

The moment when a cruel smile appeared on Euphrosyne's lips.

[You guys are right.]

The balance of the world began to creak.

[Many Constellations would like to view this scenario.]

[The Constellations of the Gourmet Association are willing to pay for the probability of proceeding with this scenario!]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is moving.]

There were just scenario messages being exchanged, but probability was flying out of thin air. A transfer that has occurred only a few times in 'Ways of Survival' and 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

And I knew when this 'miracle' would occur.

「When the scenario difficulty level is increased abnormally.」

I felt dizzy and felt like my stomach was turning. It was difficult to move my body as if the gravity of the area had been reversed.

When I shook my head several times and finally came to my senses, a message appeared before my eyes.

[The number of the scenario will change.]

[You are qualified to participate in the '20th Main Scenario'.]

---

The banquet was halted for a moment.

This is because the Constellations of the Zodiac and the incarnations each needed time to recover from the shock.

The twentieth main scenario.

Suddenly the scenario level rose by eleven levels. Although it was rare in mid- to late-game scenarios, I've never seen this happen in the ninth scenario.

The fact that the scenario level has risen by 11 levels means that the scenario difficulty has also been upgraded accordingly.

[Does this make sense—]

Some high-ranking Constellations began to protest.

[Who can control the difficulty level of the scenario...]

[Since when did the <Star Stream> become your playground!]

The Constellations in the zodiac, unable to bear it, pointed their pointed fingers at the Dokkaebis in the air.

I waited for the next message without reacting in any way.

This level of dramatic change in scenarios will inevitably bring about probability repercussions. So, if it were as I expected, the Management Bureau would have put in place a safety device to prevent any repercussions.

['Ninth Scenario' participants can choose to participate in the '20th Scenario'.]

[If you choose not to participate, you will be kicked out of the 'Recycling Center'.]

[For the deportees, a new 'ninth scenario' is rehabilitation.]

I knew it. No matter how bad the Star Stream is, it was reasonable.

[Damn, if that’s the case, I’d tell you right away—]

[I, I will not participate in the scenario!]

In other words, you are free to choose whether to participate in a new scenario or not.

Constellations from all over began to leave the 'Recycling Center', taking incarnations with them.

It was an obvious choice.

No Constellation would want to participate in this unpleasant scenario.

[Well, there are already Constellations who are making hasty choices.]

At least, unless there is corresponding compensation.

[That's too bad. With the reward from this scenario, even a low-ranking Historical-grade Constellation could instantly become a Narrative-grade Constellation...]

The Constellations on the <Zodiac> side, who were leaving the scenario, stopped as Euphrosyne muttered to herself.

[What does that mean? A Historical-grade immediately becomes a Narrative-grade?]

[If you're curious, wouldn't it be okay to stay in the scenario? Oh, I'm not forcing it.]

Maybe there is no freedom in this world. The idea of free choice is nothing more than a mirage.

[Is it real?]

[You can't lie about compensation.]

[If it is to the extent of immediately upgrading the level of a Historical-grade to the level of a Narrative-grade... Is it really possible that a mythical story will be released as a product?]

[Hey, are you really leaving? There may never be another opportunity like this.]

[If the reward is that much in the 20th scenario, it's worth a try.]

[It's better than suffering outside. The Gourmet Association is annoying, but…]

A muffled laugh could be heard from beyond the curtains on the second floor.

They probably already knew. The fact that the Constellations on the first floor would never be able to reject this proposal.

In the end, the destination of the stars' desires is the same. It's the same whether it's a Historical-grade, a Narrative-grade, or a Mythical-grade.

[Ah, for those of you who are curious, let me show you the scenario rewards in advance...]

And maybe me too.

[Have you all heard of it? This is one the ‘Fragments of the Oldest Dream’ that have been floating around the world recently.]

The moment I saw the image rising behind Euphrosyne, time seemed to stop.

[I am introducing. Fragments of 'the Oldest Dream'.]

'Kim Dokja', who had the same face as me, was sealed in the tank.

He sacrificed himself to save me, my brother who was consecrated to the scenario.

[This is the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

---

The Demon King of Salvation.

In the pitch-black night sky, Lee Gilyoung rewrote those words with his fingers several times. The trace imbued with pure white magic was quickly erased, but Lee Gilyoung constantly filled in new traces on top of the disappearing trace.

"What are you doing?"

Lee Gilyoung turned his head halfway in response to the question and then fixed his gaze on the sky again. Then the owner of the voice took Lee Gilyoung’s hat off.

"Now, when your noona calls you, you don’t even look at her."

"What. Why?"

“Teen angst?”

Lee Jihye, who took Lee Gilyoung's hat, placed his hat on her own head. The hat fit well without any need to adjust the size.

Lee Gilyoung grumbled and said.

"If you came here to start a fight, just leave."

Lee Jihye looked down at the back of the boy's pouty head. Lee Jihye actually knew why the back of this boy's head was so prickly.

「The condition for activating [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] is for the ahjussi and the target to think about each other at the same time.」

Lee Jihye, who was looking down at Lee Gilyung who had stopped, drew her sword and wrote letters in the air.

The Demon King of Salvation.

Letters engraved like a calligrapher's calligraphy.

Lee Gilyoung asked with his mouth slightly open.

"Do you know how to do that too? Teach me too."

Lee Jihye sighed lightly and said.

"Even if I write it like this, you're going to read it to me."

"Still."

"Let's stop and go in, it's cold."

"…Hyung."

A tremor at the end of words.

Lee Jihye's steps suddenly stopped.

"Does hyung think of me sometimes?"

"Well, maybe sometimes?"

"I'm not someone else, I'm Lee Gilyoung."

"It's a circle sound."

"Shin Yoosung is the incarnation of hyung, and Sangah is hyung's best friend."

Lee Gilyoung hesitated for a moment and then continued.

"The sooty bastard, Seolhwa, and the noona are characters from a novel that hyung liked."

"Hey."

"But I am nothing."

The magic flowing from Lee Jihye's blade dimly illuminated Lee Gilyoung's face.

"Why did he save me?"

How long has the child been pondering that question alone?

"I wish I could ask him just once. It’s okay if I can’t ask him any other questions, so I wish I could ask him just once. I should have asked then. I shouldn’t have given in to Shin Yoosung."

The energy of the story slowly flowed from Lee Gilyoung’s whole body.

It was a story of the demon god Abaddon.

Lee Jihye’s expression hardened.

"Hey, calm down."

"It’s okay just once—"

"Stories are leaking!"

The moment Lee Jihye held onto Lee Gilyoung's shoulder after her urgent shout, sparks flew out in the air. At first, she thought the story of Abaddon had gone wild.

But it wasn't.

The spark was hovering in the air nearby, not at Lee Gilyoung.

"That one over there."

Not long ago, Kim Dokja, who used [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], disappeared.

A place where the world line opens and closes.

Something was flowing through that place.

The moment a nervous Lee Jihye grasped the hilt of her sword, a message was heard.

[The invitation has arrived.]

A message that somehow feels like déjà vu.

They knew this feeling of déjà vu well.

A 'scenario'.

But they already cleared all the 'scenarios' a long time ago.

But why now?

[Someone invited you to the scenario '■■■ ■■■■'.]

Why did a 'scenario' message appear before their eyes once again?

"What is this?"

It was an invitation that they would have naturally declined under normal circumstances. There was no way they would respond to such a suspicious invitation.

They would have immediately shown the message to Yoo Sangah and Lee Seolhwa and then judged the situation.

But the moment they saw the scenario message that followed.

[Through this scenario, you can meet the 'Demon King of Salvation' once again.]

There was only one option left for them.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 764 Episode 33 Ball (3)

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Immediately after the twentieth scenario product was released, the hall was filled with excitement for a while.

But do the other Constellations know who the 'Demon King of Salvation' is?

[I heard the story. He is the one who fought against Ares, who had half his powers.]

[So you are allowing me to eat his entire tale?]

[If it is possible to prey on an Ares-level Constellation, it would be possible for a Historical-grade to become a Narrative-grade in an instant.]

[But wasn’t there a guy called the Demon King of Salvation here too?]

I quietly hid behind the pillar next to the table. There was something unusual going on in the atmosphere.

I already knew that information about the 'Kim Dokja fragments' had spread outside. However, it seemed like the information was slowly starting to spread within the Recycling Center as well.

—You probably already know this.

Bihyung’s 'Dokkaebi Communication' was heard in the air.

—You know that’s a great product, right?

The term 'product' bothered me, but I nodded with effort.

'I know. Because it's my sponsor.'

The Kim Dokja sleeping in the fish tank really looked like the Kim Dokja I remembered.

Of course, I know that Kim Dokja is not that Kim Dokja. It's just the embodiment of his story.

Still, as I looked at him, a corner of my heart throbbed.

—It's not just your sponsor. Have you never heard of 'Fragments of the Oldest Dream'?

Of course it was information I knew, but I deliberately did not reply. Because I wanted to hear what Bihyung would say.

—The Oldest Dream. It is a star that is designated as the first 'cause' of all these worlds.

The first cause of all these worlds.

Did the middle and lower level Dokkaebis even know this information?

I couldn't remember very well.

Maybe it's a feature unique to the 41st Round..

—There is a story that fragments of that Constellation have recently been discovered throughout the <Star Stream>.

'My sponsor is one of them.'

—It's a very big 'one'. This information is still known only to large nebulae or high-ranking Constellations. This is what the 'Recycling Center' revealed this time.

Honestly, when I heard this, I didn't really understand it.

Even though it is only the 20th scenario, they are offering the 'Demon King of Salvation' as a scenario product?

Let's say the management bureau can do that. But does it make sense for the 'Gourmet Association' to participate in it?

If there was such a coveted story, they would be the first to taste it, right?

—Anyway, be careful with this scenario. Even if you are the 'Incarnation of the Oldest Dream', it won't be easy.

'The incarnation of the Oldest Dream?'

—Some Constellations call you that.

In that case, there was something completely wrong with the name. This is because I am the incarnation of the 'Demon King of Salvation', not the incarnation of the 'Oldest Dream'.

The incarnation of the 'Oldest Dream' refers to the guy who is now walking from the other side with wide open eyes.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

Yoo Joonghyuk from 41st Round.. The side effects of the 'Story Imprint' seem to have been alleviated considerably, and his height, which was previously that of a boy, has now returned to that of a young man.

Behind Yoo Joonghyuk stood the group, that had disappeared into the incarnation waiting room.

I lightly raised my hand towards them.

"Have you all seen the new scenario that came out?"

"Yes. What about you, Dokja-ssi? How did the Constellations react?"

"Everyone was shocked, well."

"Hey, there's nothing special about the Constellations."

Kyung Sein, who rushed over, was the first to murmur. After that, Dansu ahjussi and Cha Yerin were also seen.

"Ji Eunyu-ssi was saved by Meihouwang "

After all,it was Meihouwang. It seemed like he had safely escaped from the hunting dogs.

"My brother went somewhere alone for a while."

He probably went there to prepare for the next scenario. Killer King may seem absurd on the outside, but he is thorough when it comes to scenarios.

But my companions seemed to have something else they wanted to say.

I looked into their eyes closely and asked.

"Who else was in the waiting room?"

"There were a lot. I also saw Anna Croft and Asuka Ren."

Anna Croft and Asuka Ren.

Were they also active at the 'Recycling Center'? I don't know which faction they chose, but if we become enemies with them, things won't be easy.

"But they both got off."

I couldn't believe my ears.

"Those two quit the scenario?"

"Yes. This time, with the difficulty level being raised, it became possible to escape the scenario. They escaped right then."

Even if Asuka Ren is like that, what about Anna Croft? There is no way the Prophet could have run away even after checking the product details?

"And Anna told me to give you this."

Cha Yerin said that and handed over a crumpled paper:

—I give in this time.

The moment I read the neatly written handwriting, I smiled bitterly.

A Prophet would have already figured out how things are going here.

It was at that time that Dansu ahjussi, who had been listening and observing the conversation, opened his mouth.

"By the way, friend. Can I ask you one thing?"

"Yes. Just ask."

"That face…"

It did. I was wondering when you would ask.

I looked at my face reflected in the glass on the table.

No matter how you look at it, it's the same face as Kim Dokja.

It may have seemed strange to the party members who were familiar with Cheon Inho's face.

Dansu ahjussi, who had been pausing, asked with a heavy expression.

"Why have you suddenly become so handsome?"

I looked blankly at Dansu ahjussi. Then Kyung Sein intervened.

"Hey, ahjussi! That’s not the question!"

"Yes? Then…"

"You don’t know whose face that face is?"

"Whose face is it?"

"It’s Kim Dokja, Kim Dokja!"

"Ah."

Now that I think about it, Dansu ahjussi has only read the entire novel once.

And the favorite of Jiyoon, the daughter of Dansu ahjussi, was Yoo Joonghyuk. It wasn't strange that he didn't know Kim Dokja's face.

"Then it’s even weirder. If that’s really Kim Dokja’s face—"

"Ahjussi."

Kyung Sein grabbed Dansu ahjussi’s wrist. It was as if she was telling him not to say any more.

As expected, the sense of discomfort I felt from my companions earlier was not an illusion.

Their eyes look strangely anxious every time they look at me.

I looked at my companions with calm eyes and asked.

"What happened in the waiting room?"

In the end, Kyung Sein, who had hesitated, opened her mouth first.

"Actually, I met Ye Hyunwoo in the waiting room."

"Ah."

"And Goo Seonah. Do you remember Goo Seonah? She used to use iron guns in Chungmuro—"

"I remember."

Gu Seonah, the Cheolgon woman.

The last time I saw her was at Gwanghwamun Station.

At that time, I, who had just started reading 『Heir of the Eternal Name』, absorbed the soul of Kim Kyungsik, who became a 'Kim Dokja fragment'.

Goo Seonah, who happened to witness the scene, was greatly shocked and left Gwanghwamun.

I was worried because she hadn't been seen since, but it appears she was also a participant in this scenario.

"Seonah said something a little strange."

Kyung Sein took a deep breath and looked straight into my eyes and said.

"Don’t trust Dokja-ssi."

I thought I knew why Goo Seonah said that.

Because she clearly saw me absorbing Kim Kyungsik.

I don't know if Goo Seonah told my group in detail or not, but if that causes my group to stop trusting me...

"There’s no need to look so serious."

When I turned my head, Dansu ahjussi was speaking with stern eyes.

"If we don’t trust you, who will we trust?"

"I think so too. I was just worried that Goo Seonah said something strange, so I was wondering whether I should tell it or not. Dokja-ssi might be offended."

I once again felt sorry for my companions.

If they found out that I was becoming stronger by absorbing the 'Kim Dokja fragments', if they found out that I absorbed Kim Kyungsik’s soul… Will my companions treat me like they do now even then?

"But when I see your face, I feel like I have to tell you."

"My face?"

"Yes, because those two—"

The moment I heard the next words, I felt my heart lightly sink.

"It’s a little, but... Goo Seonah and Ye Hyunwoo also had similar faces to the current Dokja-ssi."

---

Goo Seonah and Ye Hyunwoo,

I wanted to meet them and talk to them if possible, but it seemed like they wouldn't come to the hall.

[Story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' chuckles.]

Two people turned into faces similar to mine.

It wasn't entirely unexpected. In the end, the more 'Kim Dokja fragments' we collect, the more similar we become to 'Kim Dokja'.

The fact that their facial features have changed must be proof that they have also collected a certain number of 'fragments of Kim Dokja'.

[Start entering the scenario.]

[If you agree to enter, please enter through the door in the center of the hall.]

Before we knew it, it was time to enter the scenario.

I looked back at my companions and said.

"I'm asking just in case you don't know…"

Cha Yerin answered as if she already knew my question.

"You will tell us not to participate."

"I think so."

'Twentieth' main scenario.

This scenario was of the same level of difficulty as the 73rd Demon World. Monsters equivalent to demon nobles will appear, and boss-level monsters equivalent to demon dukes or Constellations will appear.

Is that it?

We must fight against the other Constellations of the zodiac. This means that confrontations with at least Historical-grade Constellations are inevitably scheduled.

"We've fought with the Constellations before."

"The probability tolerance is different from the eighth scenario."

Most of the Constellations we faced were guys who had squandered their reputation. Even those who appeared awkwardly, bound by the probability constraints of lower-level scenarios.

However, the '20th' scenario is a different story.

Then Cha Yerin asked.

"What do you think Kim Dokja would have done?"

What would Kim Dokja have done?

None of us knew the answer.

Kyung Sein laughed.

"Have you forgotten? We are also 'Kim Dokja'."

Dansu ahjussi nodded and said.

"We also have an 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'."

I sighed lightly and said.

"You know that survival is the top priority, right?"

My companions nodded.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been listening to the story as if he was not interested, walked past us first, and Killer King appeared from nowhere and followed him.

"Let's go."

[Entering a new scenario area!]

A bright beam of light enveloped our entire bodies and the landscape began to change.

Although I spoke calmly, I was actually very worried about this scenario.

Even in the 'Ways of Survival', the 'Recycling Center' scenario has never unfolded like it does now. The stage for this scenario was a place that even I didn't really know about.

"...Thus, the Demon King of the beginning arose from the conflict between good and evil..."

A voice that occasionally reaches my ears. It was a calm and intelligent voice. A powerful tone that feels like something I've heard before.

"...So, the cause of the Holy Demon War..."

When I slowly opened my eyes, the first thing I saw was the neat letters written on the blackboard.

「History of the Demon World.」

I stared at the blackboard for a long time, wondering if I was looking at something in vain.

But nothing changed.

Across the blackboard, I could see the backs of the students' heads sitting on chairs and taking class.

It's definitely true. This was a school.

No, why am I at school?

As I unconsciously turned my head, I saw my reflection in the window. A name tag was attached to the chest of the refreshing beige school uniform.

[Kim Dokja.]

Goosebumps slowly appeared.

"Hmm, what’s outside the window?"

The teacher was looking at me. As I slowly stood up, I could see the teacher's face more clearly.

Then I realized why I thought his voice sounded familiar.

"Would you like to talk about the 'Devil’s Justice' that I just explained?"

It was definitely true.

He is the 'Reclining Dragon' who came to the 'Recycling Center' as an evaluator.

It was Zhuge Gongming.

"Student Kim Dokja."

I took a deep breath and started talking.

"The Demon King refers to the corrupted Constellations that abandoned their own scenarios and polluted the scenario region to establish their own realm."

I was talking without even knowing what I was talking about.

How much was that noise?

[You have satisfied the unique settings for that person.]

[The world view gives you 500 coins.]

Satisfied the unique settings? What does it mean?

Teacher Waryong shook his head as if impressed.

"It’s pretty good. Well, even in inferior classes, not all are at the same level. Now, that’s it for today’s class. Everyone, prepare well for the graduation exam—"

The ding-dong music rang out, and the children who were lying face down on their desks stood up all at once.

Meanwhile, there were children coming towards me. These were all faces I had never seen before.

"Wow, how do you memorize it all? Even though I heard it, I don’t understand a thing."

"Hee, it feels like a hit."

"You idiot, this isn’t power, it’s hiding knowledge."

I looked at them quietly and cautiously opened my mouth.

"Who are you—"

Tsk tsk tsk tsk!

[You made a statement that is not appropriate for the person in question!]

I almost screamed at the lightly bouncing sparks.

[Warning. The 'Memory Loss' setting does not exist for you.]

It wasn't until I received one message after another that I began to understand little by little what the situation was.

[A new scenario has arrived.]

**<Main Scenario #20 – Graduation>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: ???

Clear Condition: You have joined the old story according to the contract with the 'Recycling Center'. Solve the scenario by finding the clear conditions for that world view.

Time limit: 15 days

Reward: Fragment of the Oldest Dream, ???

Failure: —

While reading the scenario, I thought of Euphrosyne's voice.

「Reenactment of an old story.」

Apparently, this stage seemed to be a system that imitated the Island of the Reincarnated — the 'Kaizenix Island'.

The problem is that the genre is a little different from back then.

—Kim Dokja, 3rd grade, 2nd class. Kim Dokja, 3rd grade, 2nd class, go to the teacher's office immediately…

I jumped up from my seat and headed into the hallway. As I walked down the hallway, I carefully observed the passing scenery.

First of all, this stage did not have a particularly unusual worldview. Judging from the fact that the terms Constellation, demon king, and scenario are also used the same way, it seems to share a worldview with the <Star Stream>.

Just look at my name.

Judging by the fact that my name was still 'Kim Dokja', this worldview seemed closer to a kind of 'arranged worldview' rather than possession.

For example, I am called 'Kim Dokja' just like on the outside, but my settings have been changed to fit this worldview.

Looking at the students' reactions, it seems like I am a kind of brainy character.

[Explore the clear conditions for the scenario.]

As with the Gourmet Association's 『Bracelets Expedition』, this scenario is probably not the beginning of the world view.

In short, it may be the time before an important event like 'Kaizenix.

—Third year graduation exam.

I quietly looked at the promotional flyer posted on the bulletin board.

"Oh, it’s Kim Dokja, our sunbae."

Students passing by me bowed their heads and said hello. “Sunbae ”, I can’t remember the last time I heard that word.

There were people waiting for me in front of the teacher’s office.

"Dokja-ssi! You’re here! Ugegege!"

"Sein-ssi, if you say something like that here, there will be repercussions—gegegegege!"

I don't know how many genres there are in this world, but at least one thing seems certain.

"Kim Dokja, if this continues, our class will not be able to take the graduation exam."

We became students of the 'Academy'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 765 Episode 33 Ball (4)

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There are things that commonly come to mind when you think of 'academy setting'.

"First of all, school is the main stage."

Since it is an 'academy setting', of course the setting is a school. However, you'll get bored when its about school life, so you mix in other genres.

"Everyone has their skills, so it's arranged as a 'hunter story'."

Since the skills used outside can be used here as well, it can be seen as a mix of 'academy' and 'hunter' based on abilities.

"Of course the main character will be in an inferior class."

Right. Usually, in situations like this, the inferior class wins by defeating the honors class after a lot of hard work.

"Then, after all, I am the main character?"

I ignored Killer King's nonsense and asked what I was curious about.

"You mentioned the graduation exam earlier. What do you mean?"

"You’re stupid. Have you still not grasped the worldview? Have you forgotten where our goal was?"

Killer King said that and pointed to the notice on the bulletin board.

—Information on the 3rd year graduation exam.

It was a notice I had already checked upon arrival.

"That is the goal of this scenario."

Killer King's reasoning was plausible.

The point in time when we were possessed would be just before the key events of this worldview took place. If we take into account the setting of 'third year', the 'graduation exam' was definitely the main event of this scenario.

Coincidentally, the name of the scenario is 'graduation'.

[You have found the key clue to the scenario!]

I knew it.

"By the way, Kang Ilhoon."

"I am not Kang Ilhoon."

"Are you okay with talking like that?"

Kyung Sein, who realized what I meant, intervened.

"That’s right. Since earlier, Killer King-ssi has been making comments that don’t fit the world view – Gegegegegeek!"

Kang Ilhoon— So, Killer King has been making statements that completely ignore the rules of the world view. And yet he faced no sanctions from this worldview.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

['List of characters' provides information in a format appropriate for the world view.]

| Character: Kang Ilhoon (Cha Sungwoo) |
| --- |

Potential: S

Personal Attributes: Delusionist (S), Analyst (S)

Description: One of the key characters of Class 2. He often says nonsense because he cannot distinguish between reality and delusion.

Right. If you have those settings from the beginning, does that mean it’s okay to say things like that?

—Kim Dokja, 3rd grade, 2nd class. Kim Dokja, 3rd grade, 2nd class, go to the teacher’s office immediately…

After asking for understanding from my companions, I entered the teacher’s office.

If the 'graduation exam' isn't starting right away anyway, it might be okay to calmly look around.

When I opened the door, what I saw was a spacious place filled with colorless partitions. I got a little goosebumps at the sight of the teacher's office after seeing it for the first time in a while.

…But why is that kid over there?

In one corner of the teacher's office, there was a boy with both hands above his head. It was obvious who he was just by looking at his broad shoulders and his matted black hair.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

The guy looked back at me, muttering something over and over again as if he was dissatisfied with something.

"In this kind of worldview…"

Yoo Joonghyuk closed his mouth with a “tsutsutsu” sound.

Is it really possible for that guy to not make an undignified sound (“Egegegeek”) even if he gets hit with a blowback?

Across from Yoo Joonghyuk, there was a teacher who was in the middle of disciplining him. The back view here was also familiar.

"Joonghyuk. Students are not allowed to smoke."

"I've never smoked."

"Then what is this that came out of your pocket?"

"Magic tobacco. It's an item that helps circulation of magic power and sharpens your senses."

"Isn't that cigarettes?"

I guess I know roughly what the situation is.

As I approached and cleared my throat slightly, the teacher turned to look at me.

"Ah. You are here?"

It seemed like this teacher was the one who called me.

Deep emerald eyes shining through flowing blonde hair. She was wearing a mask with a cute sheep on it, so her lower face was not revealed, but anyone could see that this Constellation was that Constellation.

'The one who brought ten lambs'.

"Sorry, I have a cold. Cough."

It definitely doesn't sound like someone with a cold.

White wings fluttered behind the teacher's back.

I wondered what to call this teacher.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

['List of characters' provides information in a format appropriate for the world view.]

Character: Teacher Sheep/Yang (The One Who Brought Ten Lambs)

Potential: Due to the difference in status, the potential of the character cannot be confirmed.

Core setting: The potential of the character cannot be confirmed due to the difference in status.

Description: Class Z's teacher. She is often scolded by the principal for being negligent in managing her children's grades. She likes to watch Internet broadcasts alone, and has the characteristic of flapping her wings when she is in a good mood.

She was quite famous during her time as an active hunter. She's scary when she's angry.

I looked closely at her fluttering wings and asked.

"Teacher Yang."

"Yes, Dokja."

Teacher Yang is looking at my face with sparkling eyes.

For some reason, I felt burdened by her gaze, so I asked her with my head down.

"Well... didn’t you call me?"

"Oh, that’s right."

Teacher Yang, shocked and surprised, smiled brightly and opened the drawer.

There was a test paper with a 0 mark in the drawer.

"You wrote a strange answer on the test yesterday. Why is that?"

Test papers fluttering before my eyes.

At a glance, you can see that the questions were intentionally checked with only the wrong answers selected.

[The 'initial settings' for that scenario are affected by how you cleared the previous scenario.]

I thought carefully about how I cleared the last scenario.

「"Kaaaaaaak!"」

「"Uh, why are you doing this—"」

「"My story! My story...!"」

Well, it certainly wasn't the normal method recommended by the scenario.

Still, isn't everyone satisfied in the end? That's why I became the representative of Zone 13.

"Are you going to rebel?"

Shit. Could it be that there is something like 'rebel' as a setting?

"Or do you just don’t want to graduate?"

I saw Teacher Yang smiling, as if somehow having fun.

[You are moving away from the core goal of the scenario.]

I answered hastily.

"I have to graduate."

"But why did you get all the answers wrong on purpose?"

"I don’t know. Could it be that Yoo Joonghyuk possessed me for a moment?"

At my words, Yoo Joonghyuk, who was looking at the wall and raising his hand, glared in this direction.

[You have satisfied the unique settings for that person.]

[The world view gives you 300 coins.]

Looking at Teacher Yang, smiling, "Ahaha", I think I roughly know what my settings are.

All I have to do is do it like Kim Dokja.

"It’s a funny joke. But if you keep joking like that, you won’t be able to graduate. What should I do?"

"Does this school not let you graduate just because you didn’t pass the test?"

"Did you know that points are awarded to each class based on the final exam score?"

I nodded for now.

Then Teacher Yang added:

"If this continues, class 2 will be 'unable to take the graduation exam' as they are below 500 points."

"That’s not possible. There’s a reason I have to graduate. Can’t I take the exam again?"

"Hmm. There is no such rule, so what?"

"You said you don’t have enough points, right? How can I increase those points?"

"There is a way."

Teacher Yang's eyes became sharp.

"That must be tricky?"

"I’ll do anything."

Teacher Yang's ears turned red as if she was thinking about what I said.

"Anything?"

---

After school, we all gathered together and picked up trash on campus.

"Come on, let’s clean up!"

Teacher Yang even took time off from work to help us volunteer on campus.

"Here too!"

"Yes."

"And there too!"

"Yes."

"Here too!"

This looks like the butt that Yoo Joonghyuk threw away after smoking earlier.

The culprit who threw away the trash was sitting on the steps of the school gate, looking at the sky and immersed in thought had an expression on his face that said he did not understand why he came into this worldview and was cleaning the campus.

"I feel like I’m 30 years younger Gegegegegeeng."

"Isn’t it fun to clean after a long time?"

On the other hand, my companions looked happy.

Killer King, who was picking up trash next to him, shook his head.

"After all, the club is a volunteer site."

"We’re not doing club activities."

"Kim Dokja, let me tell you something important."

"You don’t have to tell me."

"If you sweep like this, you can sweep up five pieces of trash at a time."

If you think about it, it wasn't strange that the group was happy.

Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, and Killer King. This is because so far we have only cleared die-hard scenarios.

After fighting for our lives every time, a mission like 'picking up trash' suddenly appeared, so this was no different from just resting.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' looks pleased.]

And maybe that's Teacher Yang's real intention.

But does Teacher Yang think she is hiding her identity well?

I looked at Teacher Yang as she glanced at me from afar for a moment, then bent down to pick up a piece of trash.

[You have earned 1 point.]

It's butts again.

Is Yoo Joonghyuk, this kid, actually a smoker? Why did he smoke so much?

"You look happy."

It was Cha Yerin who said those words.

"It’s fun."

"Then don’t you enjoy it?"

"What fun could there be in picking up butts?"

"For all that, you can see the happy look on your face ."

We had meaningless conversations and picked up trash together.

Of course, it was all a planned conversation.

To be precise, it is a decoy to hide the 'real conversation'.

—Yerin-ssi, did you recognize them?

Cha Yerin slightly nodded her head in my [group chat].

[The worldview pays attention to your actions.]

「Group chat was the only way for us to exchange opinions without the eyes of the world, but it could never be overused.」

So we decided to briefly exchange opinions in this way only when our conversations overlapped.

—Ye Hyunwoo is in class A. Goo Seonah is in class B. Ji Eunyu is in class C.

As expected, all the elite students are concentrated in the first class.

—Shin Yoosung, Jung Heewon, Lee Jihye, Kim Namwoon, and Lee Hyunsung are all in the first class.

Nice names to hear after a long time.

Most of the original characters also seemed to be placed in the front half.

—But the condition of the original characters was a bit strange.

—Their condition is strange?

—Even though they were all in different classes, they went to school with Goo Seonah.

The characters go around with Goo Seonah? Isn't it Yoo Joonghyuk?

It seems that Cha Yerin was looking for an answer in her own way. She added.

—Perhaps she has obtained the 'Delinquent story'.

Delinquent story. It doesn't seem like such a thing, but it certainly seemed like Goo Seonah had done something.

If she has been steadily collecting 'Kim Dokja fragments' all this time, and if there are fragments related to 'crowd control' among those fragments, it is not impossible.

It was never a good sign, but I answered in a refreshing voice.

—Still, the situation is not bad.

Normally, I would never have said this. The situation isn't that bad, but it's almost like a taboo in 'Omniscient Reader'.

But I wanted to say that this time. Perhaps Cha Yerin will understand what I mean.

—I see.

Maybe only she understands.

[Activate 'Character List'!]

Character: Lee Seyeon (Cha Yerin)

Potential: A+

Core Setting: Literature Girl (S)

Description: A literary girl who reads more books than anyone else in class 2, and remembers all the books she has read even once. There is a strange amount of information about the Academy.

We looked at the sunset-filled campus with wry smiles.

—I didn't know that this 'world view' would be turned into a scenario.

I also nodded.

—Class number identified by alphabet. The background setting is similar to 'Omniscient Reader'. Constellations and Demon Lords. And…

We simultaneously looked at the school name written on the campus.

'Philia Hunter Academy'.

There may be many 'academy settings' in the world, but there is only one academy with that name.

—I wonder if this is how Asuka Ren felt.

This school was the 'Hunter Academy' from the novel I had finished writing—『Infinite Prison Guard』.

In other words, this scenario was similar to the situation in 'Peace Land'.

Just as Kim Dokja received help from the original protagonist, Kyrgios, in Peace Land,

—Have you found the main character?

We just need to find the main character safely in this worldview.

「Ma Hyunsung, student of Class 2 of Philia Hunter Academy.」

The main character's name seems similar to Lee Hyunsung, but that's just a coincidence.

—Once you find that friend, this scenario is over.

Ma Hyunsung is a typical Yoo Joonghyuk type protagonist.

As long as I could get my hands on that talent, I had nothing to fear, whether the enemy in this scenario was the Chinese Zodiac or the Gourmet Association.

—That is…

However, Cha Yerin's expression was not good.

I asked just in case.

—Do you remember the main character’s name?

—Yes. But perhaps there is no Ma Hyunsung in this 'world'.

—Yes? Why? It's already time for him to transfer school…

For reference, Ma Hyunsung transferred to this school in the early third year. So Ma Hyunsung should have been a member of class 2 by now.

Cha Yerin, who hesitated for a moment, said.

—The author was asleep during the fifth scenario, so you probably don’t know.

I wondered what this was all about.

[The world view examines your movements.]

Our world view was slowly becoming suspicious of us, but we couldn't stop the conversation because the timing was right.

—What do you mean?

—Hunter Ma Hyunsung appeared as one of the disasters in the 'fifth scenario'.

—Huh?

I instinctively looked at the campus's entrance. Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been sitting on the landing a moment ago, had disappeared somewhere and was nowhere to be seen.

Cha Yerin said.

—Hunter Ma Hyunsung was killed by Yoo Joonghyuk in the fifth scenario.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 766 Episode 33 Ball (5)

My heart was beating loudly.

Ma Hyunsung, the protagonist of 『Infinite Prison Guard』.

「That 'Ma Hyunsung' appeared in the fifth scenario of the 41st Round.」

As if that wasn't enough, he fought with Yoo Joonghyuk.

At first glance, it may seem like a battle to determine the strongest protagonist, but the situation was not that simple.

—Are you really sure that it was 'Ma Hyunsung'?

—I'm sure.

Considering common sense, it was impossible for Ma Hyunsung to appear as a disaster in the 41st Round. Aside from the distortion of the world line, several conditions were necessary to become a 'disaster' in the fifth scenario.

Like the Lesser Dragon Igneel, they are a species of monster raised in paradise, or like the Disaster of Questions, they made a contract with the Management Bureau to avoid a violation of grave probability, or like the Disaster of Floods, they dedicated their existence to the scenario for a specific purpose.

Ma Hyunsung did not seem to be the first or second case.

So he's the third case.

Is there any reason for Ma Hyunsung to be subordinate of the Management Bureau? Unless his worldview is destroyed—

As I thought about that, I let out a faint groan.

Ah.

A few settings that came to mind later. Although it had become somewhat faded with age, the information about 'Infinite Prison Guard' still remained in my head.

「Ma Hyunsung's world was destroyed.」

Although it didn't go that far in the story, it was correct to see that Ma Hyunsung's world had come to an end in a general sense. This was true both internally and externally.

What does it mean?

「Infinite Prison Guard is a novel that I stopped serializing.」

If the act of 'stopping serialization' contributed to the end of a world, then his worldview had come to a halt in time series.

Because of me, not anyone else.

But I also feel a little unfair. It may be a bit strange, but『Infinite Prison Guard』was a story that could only be completed by 'stopping serialization'.

Anyway.

—There is no way Yoo Joonghyuk could kill Ma Hyunsung.

I don't know what kind of disaster Ma Hyunsung suffered. However, the Ma Hyunsung I remember was an absolute powerhouse in the worldview of『Infinite Prison Guard』.

This means that he was the strongest person in this world right before the serialization was stopped.

—But Yoo Joonghyuk killed him. I definitely saw it.

—Can you tell what kind of disaster Ma Hyunsung caused?

—A Disaster of Memory.

A Disaster of Memory?

As far as I know, there is no such disaster.

But the name is something the <Star Stream> decided on its own.

—It was a disaster that never appeared in the main story. To be honest, I thought I didn't know the strategy well, but Yoo Joonghyuk ran out on his own and fought back.

—And what?

—In less than five minutes, Ma Hyunsung admitted defeat. He mumbled something to himself... I'm not sure, but he seemed to have a carefree face.

A light-hearted face?

[The worldview is suspicious of your actions.]

Tsutsutsu, sparks bouncing.

I guess this is the end of the conversation.

It was time to move on.

"Have you seen where this bastard Yoo Joonghyuk went?"

---

[You have earned 1 point.]

[A total of 150 points have been earned so far.]

I just picked up trash and already earned 150 points.

She said that the final goal was 500 points, so at this rate, the goal was easily achieved.

"Dokja-ssi. Would you please bring Joonghyuk-ssi? I think I'll have to end my volunteer work soon."

"Yes, but where did he go?"

"Well, well, I saw him go that way earlier—"

I walked straight along in the direction that Teacher Yang pointed out.

1st floor, 2nd floor, 3rd floor... I went up the stairs, calling Yoo Joonghyuk's name.

It was a strange feeling. I can't believe I'm going to go to school. Probably the same goes for Yoo Joonghyuk. According to the settings, he never went to school properly.

When I thought about it that way, I felt like I knew where Yoo Joonghyuk was.

Yoo Joonghyuk was on the rooftop.

If you think about it, it was natural.

For a guy who is not used to school and doesn't have good relationships with friends, there is a fixed location for him to go to.

The unfortunate thing was that even the rooftop wasn't a place he would really like.

Because the rooftop is a place where you can see the sky very clearly.

Yoo Joonghyuk was looking up at the sky as always.

He seemed to be searching for his sponsor, and he seemed to be recalling distant memories. He seemed to be gazing at the stars in the night sky, or he seemed to be gazing at the scenery of a world that had already perished.

Perhaps because of his mood, Yoo Joonghyuk's appearance looked blurry.

What round is this guy currently living through?

Is it Round 0, Round 1, or some round I don't know? In some round that everyone has forgotten, is he walking alone through the memories of a destroyed world?

Suddenly, I remembered someone's large footprints left in the snowy field.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly looked back. The guy was smoking a cigarette.

Was it blurry because of the cigarette smoke?

Judging from the fact that he was struggling to hold back his cough, it seemed that Yoo Joonghyuk was not used to smoking.

"Why are you glaring at me like that?"

"You’re staring at me too."

"I just have narrow eyes."

Even though my face has clearly changed to that of Kim Dokja, my squinted eyes cannot be corrected.

"Didn’t you hear Teacher Yang tell you not to smoke?"

"I would have said this wasn’t a cigarette."

We stood side by side in front of the rooftop railing.

When I think about it, I have never had an honest conversation with Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st Round. This is because conversations with Yoo Joonghyuk were always filled with lies for survival.

But what about now?

Even now, does he still perceive me as a 'villain who must be killed if he fails'?

"If you just throw it away, we’ll have to pick it up again—"

Yoo Joonghyuk threw the butt down despite my warning. Cha Sungwoo, who was downstairs, was seen muttering something as he quickly scooped up the butt with a dustpan.

"Get 1 point."

It seemed like he was saying that.

Yoo Joonghyuk and I stood side by side and looked at the group picking up trash on campus, Teacher Yang with her white wings fluttering, and the lush forest beyond.

「Forest of Demons.」

Philia Hunter Academy is a school created to deal with the demons that come across the 'forest'. Many students lost their lives fighting against demons there and became food for

the forest.

Even though the forest had a terrible history, it was beautiful from afar.

A forest filled with golden leaves that sucked the blood of humans and demons and bloomed with their stories.

I thought that the forest somehow resembled the <Star Stream>.

"What a beautiful sight."

"You seem to think tragedy is beautiful."

I was secretly impressed. After all, in any round, Yoo Joonghyuk is Yoo Joonghyuk

This must be Yoo Joonghyuk's first time visiting this worldview. Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk recognized what kind of place that forest was at first sight.

"Isn’t a tragedy like a comedy when seen from afar?"

"Sounds like something stupid constellations would say."

"The same goes for humans. Sometimes there are things you can only see if you look with your eyes open."

Enduring tragedy as a tragedy would also be a meaningful way of life.

However, not all humans can be like Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Rather than that, why not give me one too?"

"Buy it yourself and smoke it."

"Sell me a cigarette."

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me for a moment and then handed me a cigarette.

I looked down for a moment at the cigarette I received. I guessed why Yoo Joonghyuk smokes 'mana tobacco'.

The characteristic of the mana cigarette is 'accelerated recovery'.

An item that increases physical strength, mental strength, and magic power recovery rates at the cost of placing a burden on the user's soul.

Yoo Joonghyuk must have been smoking a lot of this tobacco in preparation for the next scenario.

I slowly inhaled the cigarette smoke and exhaled a long breath in Yoo Joonghyuk's direction.

[Exclusive skill 'Smoke Human Lv.3 Activates'.]

Acting man.

It was the ability of the reader—Kim Kyung-sik—that I absorbed.

The smoke rose just as I had intended, and soon covered Yoo Joonghyuk's entire head like a cloud.

"It looks good."

A strong magical response was felt throughout Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body, which was hidden by smoke

He looks like he's going to activate [Hundred Steps Godly Fists] at any moment and blow a hole in my stomach.

But I believe that Yoo Joonghyuk would not do that.

Because within the barrier of 'smoke',

—Yoo Joonghyuk. Did you get your memories back?

Yoo Joonghyuk would have checked the 'sentence' that only he could see.

[The worldview is paying attention to your actions.]

Because I had abused [Group Chat] so much in the past, the worldview was now starting to doubt my ability to communicate.

So this was the temporary solution I came up with.

「Acting Human. Using the skill to convey my intentions to Yoo Joonghyuk.」

"There is no need to live too hard. Sometimes you need to fill your head with hazy smoke. Just stay like that for a while."

At least on the outside, it would seem like a prank between close friends.

I hope so.

[The world view raises doubts about your actions.]

It was about 30 seconds later that Yoo Joonghyuk's [Transmission] was heard.

—I got it back to some extent.

As expected, Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to have regained a significant amount of his memories.

This probably means that he is slowly escaping from the side effects of 'Story Imprinting'.

—But you didn't ask about anything that happened. You probably have a lot of questions.

—I don't think you'll answer honestly.

—You don't know that. Now, if you have any questions, feel free to ask. Aren’t we colleagues now?

Yoo Joonghyuk had no answer when asked about being a colleague.

And after a while, this answer came back.

—I know you are not 'Cheon Inho'.

—You're so quick-witted.

—Is 'Kim Dokja' your real name?

—You don't need to know that. However, it’s okay if you call me that.

Yoo Joonghyuk's face was obscured by smoke, so it was impossible to tell what expression he was making.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was silent for a moment, asked.

—Where did 'Cheon Inho' go?

It seems that 41th round Yoo Joonghyuk also doesn't know where the real owner of my body has gone.

—I don’t know either. When I possessed this body, Cheon Inho was not there.

—There is no way he would have given up his body so obediently. There must have been a purpose.

—Are you familiar with Cheon Inho?

It was a question I had always wondered about.

What on earth was the relationship between Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho in 40th round?

In Anna Croft's memories, the two were enemies. They were also enemies of Bulbuldaecheon, who aimed their swords at each other and aimed at each other's necks.

—I do not know.

—For that matter, did you make any promises?

It seemed the same.

I remembered the day I first met Yoo Joonghyuk.

Oksu Station.

When I was still playing 'Cheon Inho', Yoo Joonghyuk said as soon as he saw me.

—I said it then. 'Don’t come visit me until the work I asked you to do is done.'

When we first met, Yoo Joonghyuk thought I was 'Cheon Inho', and he gave me orders.

To do what you are told to do.

—What exactly is the contract you and Cheon Inho made in the last round?

The contract shared between Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho in the 40th round. I felt like I could only find out the secret of this round if I knew the details of the contract.

—Yoo Joonghyuk?

As expected, Yoo Joonghyuk had no answer this time. I thought it might be possible. Yoo Joonghyuk's memories have not fully returned yet. And maybe some of his memories are gone forever.

—I don’t remember the exact details of the contract with Cheon Inho.

Is that so?

I nodded, trying hard to hide my disappointment. However.

—But I remember what the 'first' thing I asked Cheon Inho was.

Yoo Joonghyuk, enveloped in a cloud of smoke, was speaking.

—Rehabilitate the villains of the <Star Stream>, including the Ten Evils... I had ordered them to be made of people who would be helpful in the scenario.

I asked back with my mouth open in a daze.

—Are you serious?

—Yes.

When I thought about it, Cheon Inho in the 40th round was one of the Ten Evils, and a great man who could have been the same villain as his colleagues. So, from Yoo Joonghyuk’s perspective, it was not strange for him to give such an order.

The intention was probably to make this round run well by coaxing the top ten villains.

I sighed lightly and said.

—Then it's a pity. Unfortunately, I…

—You kept your promise.

—Yes?

I paused for a moment and then asked.

—What does that mean?

Yoo Joonghyuk's expression couldn't be seen clearly because it was obscured by smoke, but I could vaguely see where he was staring.

The direction he is looking is towards the bottom of the campus.

It was in the direction where my colleagues were.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 767 Episode 33 Ball (6)

Soon, Yoo Joonghyuk came out of the smoke. His eyes were still focused on my colleagues.

Cha Sungwoo, Cha Yerin, Lee Dansu, and Kyung Sein.

I couldn't tell which of them he was looking at.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke clearly.

He said, 'He kept his promise.'

What on earth does that mean?

Could it be that one of them was one of the Ten Evils, or an equivalent villain, in Yoo Joonghyuk's previous round?

If so.

Can we say that it was just a coincidence that I and the readers possessed 'villain' characters?

"Kim Dokja."

Yoo Joonghyuk's expression, who came out of the smoke, was strangely stiff.

Someone was opening the school gate and coming in.

「A slim body and a pitch-black cloak. A deeply pressed black hat and a black mask reminiscent of steampunk.」

The boy slowly raised his head and was looking at us.

I felt strange inside.

"This year’s graduates are terrible."

The boy who was clearly in front of the school gate was behind me the next moment.

The speed is such that even Yoo Joonghyuk can't react.

The moment when Yoo Joonghyuk, with his eyes wide open, reflexively tries to activate [Hundred Steps Godly Fists ].:

"Ah, you’re here!"

Teacher Yang flapped her wings and flew up to the rooftop. Teacher Yang took turns introducing us and the boy.

"Guys, say hello. This is 'Old School' from class 2, who came to help you with this graduation exam."

Old school?

That kid is a graduate of this school?

"This friend’s name is—"

"Get your mind straight."

The boy shot back in a cold voice and glanced at us with murderous eyes.

"When you go into that forest, it’s common to find yourself in a situation like just now. Next time I see you not be vigilant again—"

The boy glared at me with a cold gaze and warned me in a tone like Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Then I will kill you myself."

To be honest, when I first entered this worldview, I was optimistic about the situation.

It is not a different worldview, but the worldview of the novel I serialized.

Even though the difficulty level of the worldview was the worst, I thought it was worth a try. Because I did not enter this world alone.

Because there are readers and other characters.

For example,

"What? Get out."

Yes, Kim Namwoon can do that.

He's not a really smart guy, so it wouldn't be surprising if he didn't recognize me.

"Kim Namwoon, stop bullying the kids in inferior classes."

But Lee Jihye was there too.

"Namwoon. We are not a gang, but a student council."

Lee Hyunsung too.

"What’s wrong with your outfit? What’s wrong with your tie?"

It was a bit shocking to see that even Jung Heewon, the vice president of the student council, did not recognize me at all.

At first, I thought they couldn't recognize me because my face had changed, but that didn't seem to be the case.

"Excuse me."

"Yes"

"Oh, no. I guess I saw it wrong."

Shin Yoosung seemed to recognize me a little, but then her face turned red and she ran away.

I was wondering if they were suffering from a status abnormality, so I tried using [Character List].

['Character list' cannot be used for this person.]

Never before has such a message appeared to a 'character'. It was even impossible for such a message to appear to a person who I had already used [Character List] on.

That wasn't the end of the strange messages.

[Someone is viewing the 'character information' of the person in question.]

Is there someone other than me who can use [Character List]?

No, rather, could [List of Characters] be written this way?

「The information of the person being viewed by someone cannot be read.」

In the main story, two characters with [Character List] never faced each other.

Because Kim Dokja was a unique being.

But this time things were a little different. The reason was obvious.

"It’s Goo Senoah!"

A voice came from one end of the hallway. As I watched the noisy students split up like waves, I realized who the 'main character' chosen by this world view was.

"Student President Goo Seonah."

Talented, excellent grades, outstanding in literature and martial arts. The protagonist of Class A, who possessed all the so-called 'main character attributes', was walking.

The moment my eyes met hers, I understood the words of Dansu ahjussi and Kyung Sein.

「She looks like Kim Dokja.」

I felt like I finally knew what that meant. Indeed, her face subtly resembled mine.

[Story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' growls.]

If Kim Dokja had a daughter or younger sister, would she have a face similar to mine?

Every time she approached, the students became agitated.

I'm nervous. If this is really an 'academy setting', now is the time for something to happen.

「An incident where the excellent class A started a fight with the inferior class 2.」

However, as if to avoid such academic clichés, Goo Seonah quietly glared at me right in front of me and passed by.

However, she left a strange comment.

—It won’t work out the way you think.

I reached out for her arm as she passed by.

I know why you are against me, but I wanted to tell you that there is a misunderstanding. Now is not the time to fight among ourselves, and this is not a scenario to be wasted.

But.

"It’s difficult."

My hand was caught in Lee Hyunsung’s large grip.

An inexplicable feeling of disappointment suddenly rose up. But I didn't know what to say. It was unclear whether this feeling I was feeling right now was appropriate.

At that time, someone grabbed Lee Hyunsung by the collar.

"You idiot, are you sure that you don’t even recognize Kim Dokja?"

It was Killer King.

"That guy is Kim Dokja. The same Kim Dokja you were protecting. But Lee Hyunsung, how dare you—!"

"W-what are you doing?"

Lee Hyunsung, who was embarrassed, was grabbed by Killer King and shook helplessly.

"Kang Ilhoon-ssi."

Only after hearing what I said did Killer King let go of the hand that was holding Lee Hyunsung's collar. Lee Hyunsung looked at us with a puzzled expression and soon followed after Goo Seonah.

Killer King muttered as he watched Lee Hyunsung's back as he walked away.

"Don’t you feel unfair?"

"What do you mean?"

"They are your colleagues."

Colleague.

For some reason, the moment I heard those words, I felt like I was in a daze.

"Is there no way?"

"…"

"I heard from Yerin. It seems like this world was created by you."

I couldn't answer anything.

Because I don't have the 'Delusionist' attribute.

"I understand that the <Star Stream> has a system that notifies the original author with a citation when borrowing a world view."

I also had the same question as Killer King.

If this world was truly the 『Infinite Prison Guard』 that I know, I should have been notified before the scenario began.

Asuka Ren, the copyright holder of 'Peace Land', also received a similar email from tIs123.

But I didn't receive any message.

Why? Is it saying that it doesn't need to ask me for permission?

"And who is that guy again?"

When I raised my head at Killer King's words, I saw the shadow of a boy glaring at me from a dark place on the stairs.

"I don’t know either."

It was definitely the unidentified old school boy I saw the other day.

After that, the boy appeared near me every time and said the same thing.

—If you don’t come to your senses, I will kill you.

What's certain is that he doesn't seem like a person who would kill me.

---

We continued cleaning at Teacher Yang's request.

"Class Z might not be able to participate in the graduation exam?"

"I’m still cleaning—"

We collected and collected points. 200 points, 300 points, 400 points.

It would have been nice to receive another task with more points, but unfortunately, there were no tasks left.

"There was a reason why Teacher Yang had us clean."

This was because all other point assignments were completed in the 'honors class'.

"It’s actually a good situation, you know."

Cha Yerin would know.

「'Cleaning' was a task Ma Hyunsung performed every day until graduation.」

Even in the original work, the main character, Ma Hyunsung, performed a 'cleaning task' every time. That was because he had the trait of [compulsive cleaning], but there was another purpose as well.

[You are currently carrying out 'campus cleaning'.]

[While performing 'school cleaning', you may enter restricted areas of the school.]

'Closed sports warehouse' in the annex.

'Behind the teacher’s office' used for storing old teaching materials.

The 'secret library' in the school library.

The advantage of the cleaning assignment is that you can access the 'hidden places' of the school as a student.

The main character, Ma Hyunsung, performed this task every time and acquired hidden items, and the same was true for us.

"Oooh! Dokja-ssi! Look at this!"

The first place where an item was discovered was the 'Closed Sports Warehouse'.

SSS level item, 'Ancient Insect Toshi'.

It was an upwardly compatible item with the 'Hermit’s Cloak' with its 「Camouflage」 story.

"I’ll give this to you."

A concealment item that can be used by manipulating insects and using the power of the King Chungjong, is suitable for use by Dansu ahjussi with low physical strength.

Next, there was an item found 'behind the teacher’s office'.

SSS level item, 'Tin Armor'.

The tin armor was worn over CPR training material.

Honestly, I had no idea this was here. This is because this item is one that even 'Ma Hyunsung', the main character in the main story, could not obtain.

「Evolution material for 'Steel Lumberjack Armor'.」

This item could later be upgraded to 'Steel Lumberjack Armor', one of the relics of the Master of Steel, by purchasing materials.

"Sein-ssi should use this."

"Is that really okay?"

"It's possible."

"Aaaah!"

Lastly, in the 'Secret Library', I found a half-glove with a small jewel embedded in it.

'Hyeoloksu' of Hyeolgwiin, a retired master of the first martial arts group.

Among the group, there are two people who are good at martial arts .

However, since Yoo Joonghyuk did not show much interest, the owner of the item naturally became Cha Yerin, who fights based on [Daejeon fighting].

"Thank you."

Cha Yerin smiled faintly, as if she liked the newly acquired gloves.

"But Dokja-ssi, you didn’t get anything…"

"I’m fine."

The items I have obtained so far are sufficient.

The only thing I lack right now is magical ability.

Fortunately, I was making up for the lack of magical power by inhaling the 'mana tobacco' that Yoo Joonghyuk had left on the rooftop after school.

As I watched the group grow, I was reminded of Ma Hyunsung, the main character in 『Infinite Prison Guard』.

Perhaps Ma Hyunsung in the story felt the same way as me.

「'Infinite Prison Guard' is the story of the main character, Ma Hyunsung, gathering his colleagues to subdue the 'Forest of Demons.'」

In the story, Ma Hyunsung finds the special skills of the students in class 2, and strengthens their power by matching items and equipment together. As a result, Class 2 sheds its stigma of being an inferior class and proudly participates in the 'graduation exam' along with the honors class.

「The graduation exam involves hunting the 'target demon' in the 'Forest of Demons'.」

However, the story becomes somewhat worse from that point on.

「During the graduation exam, Ma Hyunsung loses his colleagues.」

In that fight, Ma Hyunsung loses all his companions, but after awakening, he succeeds in subduing the great demons.

And Ma Hyunsung witnesses the truth of this world at the end of the forest.

[You have reached the world ending.]

It turns out that this world he fought for, risking his life, was an elaborately created 'virtual reality'.

[Do you want to 'replay' the world?]

It turns out that Ma Hyunsung's world was destroyed a long time ago, and he was the last surviving human being.

He was reliving the same memory over and over again through his awakening ability, [Save].

Although he knows that the ending of the save file is fixed, he forgets that fact and repeats the world being destroyed infinitely each time.

"Thanks to you, the school is tidy. Good job, friends."

We looked at the cleaned campus with Teacher Yang.

Ma Hyunsung, who pressed the 'replay' button, must have cleaned this campus several times. Even though he knew that the campus would become dirty again, he would have continued to clean up the trash.

For those he remembers, for those who leave cigarettes on this campus and leave footprints.

「"Cleaning has to be done every day."」

Even though he knew the identity of the world, Ma Hyunsung did not destroy the save file.

Rather, in order to remember this destruction, he repeats this world over and over again for an infinite amount of time.

And is it really a coincidence that the 'Recycling Center' chose this 'Infinite Prison Guard' out of many

worldviews?

Teacher Yang spoke to us with a satisfied smile.

"Now that you have reached all 500 points, there is now the final step."

"Is there anything else left?"

"Well, you need to get approval for the exam... Dokja, can you follow me for a moment? Only the principal can give approval for the graduation test."

I nodded and followed after Teacher Yang.

"Are you going to the principal’s office?"

"Yes."

We walked down the cleaned hallway together. When we walked around looking at the playground we cleaned up together, we walked a little slowly. The school playground covered with bright green grass looked like a field of heaven.

"Teacher."

Teacher Yang glanced behind me at my question.

"How did you become a teacher?"

"Well, it’s a secret."

"Do you get paid a lot if you become a teacher?"

Teacher Yang laughed lightly at my words.

"It’s unpaid."

"Yes? Then why are you doing it?"

"Dokja."

"Yes?"

Teacher Yang, who was walking ahead, stopped. I stopped next to Teacher Yang.

"Once you get to the principal’s office, the graduation exams will really start. Then you won’t be able to stop. I mean—"

Teacher Yang continued speaking after a moment.

"You don’t have to graduate."

"Then I have to continue to be a student."

"If you are a student, your teacher can protect you."

Teacher Yang's eyes moved slowly. I also turned my head to follow her gaze.

"It’s okay to make mistakes here. Even if you throw away trash or break the rules, you just have to get punished like cleaning the school grounds."

We looked out the window together. A lush forest stretched beyond the playground we cleaned.

Ma Hyunsung said.

「The forest hides the truth.」

Like Ma Hyunsung, I too will go beyond that forest.

And maybe I'll discover a truth I don't want.

"I have to graduate. That’s why I came to school."

"You don’t have to."

"If I don’t graduate."

I saw Teacher Yang.

Actually I know.

Why were we able to spend our time cleaning leisurely?

Why was the 'graduation exam', which was supposed to start right away, delayed?

In this harsh worldview, why has 'nothing happened' to us yet?

"It’s hard to be a teacher."

The star who loved Kim Dokja more than anyone else in 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

The teacher's eyes widened as if she was looking at me.

I left the teacher behind and started walking alone. A few steps away was the door to the teacher's office.

Standing in front of the door, I slowly looked back at her.

"Thank you, Uriel."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 768 Episode 33 Ball (7)

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「“Uriel. What on earth were you thinking when you brought that 'sheep'?"」

Archangel Uriel still remembers the events of that day.

「"Did you know that she didn't know what kind of sheep the scribe asked her to bring him is?"」

The voices of angels whispering as they looked at the sheep she was dragging.

Uriel frowned at them and thought.

Knowing what kind of 'sheep' that 'sheep' is. While you're worrying about things like that, it's better to pick off one more devil's head.

「"Anyway, I brought ten of them?"」

Her calling is to hunt down demons and kill the demon king. Archangel Uriel was born only for this.

Countless numbers of demons died under her swordplay.

Devil. Ephedra. drank.

No matter what stars had the letter 'Ma' attached to them, they could not escape her blade. Hundreds or even thousands of years for the lights of constellations belonging to the 'absolute evil' go out.

As the unfathomable time of the month passed, the universe she belonged to gradually became darker.

「"Why are you killing the demon kings?"」

When was the last time she was asked that question? Was it when she heard that a new demon king had been launched on the border?

「"I received orders."」

「"If it's an order, is it to kill anyone?"」

Like that , Uriel also killed the Demon King's lover. Because that was also the order she received.

「"Daechonsai. You are like a demon king."」

The Demon King touched his lover who had lost her life and cursed silently.

「"Archangel who loves nothing. Someday, you too will love something. When that time comes, the fire you have caused will judge you."」

「"Whatever."」

Uriel laughed at those words and cut off the Demon King's head.

'Demon-like judge of fire'.

The name of hers, feared by archangels and by absolute evil, was thus determined.

As the saying goes, she killed the demon kings. They were cut to death, stabbed to death, and beheaded. How many demon kings did she kill like that?

「"Uriel. Stop 'hunting demons'."」

One day, her mission was interrupted. This was because too many demon kings died.

「"An armistice agreement has been concluded."」

When she first heard about the agreement, Uriel thought that the Scribe was making a fuss about her again.

But as a year, ten years, and even half a century passed without the war recurring, Uriel realized something was strange.

「"Wait a minute. This is really a truce?"」

「"Uriel. I think I said that fifty years ago."」

「"No, really, really?"」

「"It's really real."」

「"Then can’t we kill the demon kings now?"」

「"It's not possible."」

Uriel was dumbfounded.

She is a being born to defeat all demon kings.

She didn't run so far to find this vague peace or to face this kind of ending.

「"No. I will keep killing, I will kill everyone!"」

In the end, after being bound and dragged into Jophiel's [Bound for Good and Evil], Uriel wrote a memorandum.

「"I swear in the name of the Archangel that from now on I will never touch the Demon Kings without an order from the Scribe...■. So what do you want me to do now? If I can't even kill the Demon—"」

「"Why do you have to kill?"」

「"Then?"」

「"You can at least take care of the sheep."」

At first she thought it was a joke.

「"Sheep? What sheep?"」

Uriel was assigned to Zone 8 of the Garden of Eden—'Sheep Pasture'.

「"No, really?"」

「"It's true. Don't ask me again in after 50 years this time."」

How on earth did this happen?

Why did the archangel, who had been fighting demons until the end of the war, become a mere shepherd?

Just then, a sheep lunged towards her.

Uriel reflexively moved her sword and struck the sheep's head. As the fainted sheep fell down, a low-ranking angel who witnessed the scene came running screaming.

「"W-Wh-Uriel-nim! What on earth are you doing?!"」

「"This guy rushed in first."」

「"it rushed in because it’s happy to meet you!"」

Uriel asked back in an annoyed voice, as if she didn't know anything about that.

「"But who are you?"」

「"Didn’t you hear anything from the Scribe ?"」

That was a low-level shepherd angel whose name she can't even remember anymore.

「"For me… please just call me Teacher Yang".」

It was her first meeting with 'Teacher Yang'.

[NOTE 1]

Originally, no sheep lived in the Garden of Eden. This is because the 'sheep' in <Eden> was only a metaphor until Uriel brought the sheep in question.

「"It is a descendant of those sheep?"」

But that metaphor has now become real.

「"Yes."」

「"Don’t be kidding. I brought in 10 sheep."」

「"How many years do you think it’s been since then?"」

Uriel looked at the sheep running through the garden with blank eyes.

One, two, three, four.

The number of sheep is so large that even if you fall asleep, you won't notice.

She suddenly came to her senses and asked.

「"What about the children I brought?"」

「"Uriel-sama. I'll say it again, how many years do you think has passed..."」

She said the sheep she brought in were already dead. A long time ago.

Before she knew it, they had lived out their own lives and died. But they also gave birth to many children.

So the number of sheep in the Garden of Eden, which was only ten, became twenty, thirty, and over a hundred. And now.

「"Did you really not know? Our sheep are quite famous."」

The amount has become so large that they even appear as helpers in people's dreams.

「"I recently gave one to the goddess Artemis who came to visit."」

It is said that sometimes lambs are distributed to gods from other nebulae.

Uriel, who had been listening to Teacher Yang's boast with one ear, asked.

「"How many banches are like this?"」

「"There are 72 in total."」

Uriel imagined sheep jumping around over 72 gardens. But it didn't work out.

「"It's all thanks to Uriel."」

「"What?"」

「"This is the peace we gained thanks to Uriel defeating the Demon Kings."」

The sheep, who had fainted after being hit on the head earlier, was seen waking up again. The sheep that had been shaking their heads staggered towards Uriel again.

Teacher Yang bent down and stroked the sheep’s head. The sheep looked up at Uriel with a dumb expression and started eating the grass on the floor again.

Uriel slowly sat down on the floor while looking at the sheep.

It was definitely her first time seeing this sheep. But when she looked closely, it seemed like he was a descendant of the guy she once brought in.

「"I see."」

She doesn't know what significance there was to the time she lived.

Just counting the endless sheep, Uriel acknowledged that she was 'temporarily' relieved of her duties after half a century.

But that was the problem.

What should an archangel who has lived by picking off demon kings' heads for thousands of years do now?

She can spend a day or two watching and counting sheep, but she can't just be a shepherd forever—

「"Hmm?"」

Uriel found Teacher Yang watching a video on a portable device next to her.

「"You. What is that?"」

「"Give it back too!"」

「"What are you looking at with this?"」

「"Hey, it’s a sheep."」

She found out later that Teacher Yang was addicted to 'broadcasting'.

「"That... is a sock in a metaphorical sense."」

Uriel narrowed her eyes and glared at Teacher Yang's small mobile device.

A video was playing inside the device.

「"Calm down, Yoo Sangah."」

And soon, for the first time, Uriel understands the meaning of 'sheep' mentioned by Metatron.

「"Think of it this way. You are now in the game."」

---

Now it was all a story of the distant past. Even though that much time had not passed, Uriel often felt somewhat distant when she looked back on that time.

「"Uriel."」

A lot happened after that.

The Holy Demon War broke out again and she went to the battlefield again.

<Eden> was destroyed.

Her scribes and other archangels died, and so did all the archangels who laughed at her when she brought her sheep.

「"What about the sheep?"」

Teacher Yang said.

「"Today was the day I was supposed to shave their wool…"」

A low-level angel who died without leaving behind any stories, leaving behind those foolish last words.

Uriel still didn't know his name.

She was left alone in <Eden>, a small garden where all scenarios had ended and there was not a single sheep left.

Sometimes she would go down to earth and interact with the incarnations, sometimes she would meet Gabriel, and she would dance or sing when she was in the mood, but most of the time she was in this garden.

In this garden she slept, and occasionally she ate something.

And she saw a story.

「"Uriel, you know. This is just such a story."」

She watched and watched one star die.

The only story she kept from her ruined world.

The main character of that story is no longer in this world. No one knows where he went.

Even though she knew that fact — perhaps because she knew that fact — Uriel continued to enjoy the story without doing anything.

And sometimes she thought about sheep.

She dreamed that her boy, her sheep, was living somewhere unknown to her.

In that world, he will meet new colleagues, a man, and experience a new history.

He may have started another group without her knowledge.

[It’s been a while. Eden's 'election'.]

For a moment, Uriel thought she had heard wrong. Is it a dream?

[This. Have you still been reading this story?]

No matter how much she thought about it, he was a being who could not appear here. Because in her memories, he found his ■■ and disappeared.

No, she doesn't know if he's really dead.

She knew nothing about his final moments in ■■.

In fact, she wasn't really interested.

[You still like this story. You are also very consistent.]

Anyway, he spoke to her in his familiar tone of voice.

[But if you've seen this, isn't it time to start wondering about the next episode?]

Next episode.

[There is a place where you can see the next story.]

Maybe this is an illusion. Maybe she's hearing hallucinations because she's been watching one story for too long. Nevertheless, Uriel wanted to believe his words.

[Just keep in mind. You can only watch the story from there. There can be no intervention, no interference whatsoever.]

Even if it's a fantasy, it's okay. If only she could see that star once again.

[Ah, finally, a new modifier is needed to enter there, because it is a place with some unusual rules.]

The owner of the voice looked at the dreamscape and shook his head.

[Hmm, there are a lot of sheep in your dreams. It just worked out well. To enter there, 'animal' must be included in the modifier.]

And that was the whole story of how Uriel came to this 'scenario'.

[Your temporary modifier is 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs'.]

[You are performing the 'role' of the scenario.]

[Your role is 'Teacher Yang'.]

[You can never intervene in the development of the scenario.]

Uriel was grateful for her story.

She said she was very fortunate to have brought ten lambs to Eden at that time.

She was fortunate to meet Teacher Yang.

She was very fortunate that she was the archangel of Eden, the Demon-like Judge of Fire.

"Thank you, Uriel."

The door to the teacher's office was closing.

Uriel staggered towards the closing door.

"Dok…"

Sparks fluttering lightly.

Even though it was a name allowed in this worldview, there were signs of a fallout.

Perhaps the world view had noticed. The name she just called wasn't just a 'role' that existed in this world.

[The worldview warns you.]

It's the story she loves most.

Uriel shouted that name with all her might.

The door didn't open.

---

The door to the teacher's office closed, and the voice of the archangel I knew echoed beyond the door.

My heart was beating loudly.

As expected, 'Teacher Yang' was Uriel.

To be exact, it is not the 'Uriel' of this world line, but the Uriel from the 3rd round that I remember.

The 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' who loved Kim Dokja’s story.

One time I wanted to call her name.

Even if I couldn't become the real Kim Dokja she was looking for, I wanted to repay her for her story. Even if in return she will suffer the punishment of this worldview.

I closed my eyes tightly, waiting for the possible aftereffects to strike from thin air.

But no matter how long I waited, the aftermath did not come.

[Like that.]

Instead, someone's deep voice was heard.

[It is against the rules to call that 'name' here.]

The principal's office is pitch black.

"I think what you just said was against the rules."

[Oh, that’s right.]

Light slowly turned on in the principal's office, and the principal's face appeared.

[This 'principal’s office' is an exception.]

The 'Recycling Center Director' was sitting there.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: yang = sheep in korean***

# 769 Episode 33 Ball (8)

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In 'Ways of Survival', the 'Recycling Center Director' changes depending on the round.

The head of a small and medium-sized nebula like <Tamra> was in charge of the Recycling Center, and the renegade Abyssal Black Flame Dragon once turned the Recycling Center into his playground, and Reinheit, the owner of the Ten Evils-Paradise, who awakened as the 'Demon King', opened the Recycling Center as 'double'. There was also a time when it was used as a 'first paradise'.

However, the 'Recycling Center Director' of this 41st Round was none of them.

I did not feel the spirit of a small or medium nebula leader, the playfulness of a black flame dragon, or the madness of Reinheit.

All I can feel is a neat and calm atmosphere. It felt exactly like the principal of 'Philia Hunter Academy' I had imagined.

"You are the head of the Recycling Center—"

A spark of probability pressed through my whole body along with the sound of "tsutsutsu". It was my last act of dignity not to scream.

[Uh huh, such remarks are prohibited here.]

"Wasn’t it okay in the principal’s office?"

[I’m the only one who’s okay with that.]

It certainly seems like that. Because there was no sense of 'world view' around the principal.

"With your authority, principal, please make it okay for me for a moment."

[That's difficult, because you speak too well. For now, just stick to your role.]

"I’m good at speaking?"

[I only hear what I want to hear. Is there anyone who doesn't know about your cunning tongue?]

I thought for a moment whether the joke was about 'me' in this worldview, or about Kim Dokja from the <Star Stream>.

[What brought you here today?]

"Well, that’s it."

[The graduation exam date is slowly approaching. Is that perhaps why you came?]

You are kind enough to take care of my business first. However, I had no intention of performing my 'role' so obediently.

"I just came here to discuss my concerns."

[Consultation for concerns?]

"If you were a benevolent principal, you would listen to your students’ concerns, right?"

The principal looked at me with narrowed eyes. It seemed like he was watching my plans.

[Good. Try it.]

"I’ve been worried about my career path lately."

[Weren’t you an aspiring member of the 'swordsman club'?]

I guess that was the original setting.

But I have no intention of going as planned.

"Recently, I’m more interested in 'records' than knives."

[Records?]

"Yes. Actually, I—"

As I said those words, I looked up somewhere in the sky. I was curious as to whether this statement would offend the world view or not.

"I’ve been writing some novels lately."

[The world view-only attribute 'Reader (S)' is activated.]

[Your actions gain probability through the effect of 'Reader (S)'.]

I knew it.

Since my name is Kim Dokja, how can I not have this characteristic?

[My world view is confused by your speech.]

The principal seemed somewhat surprised, as if he had never thought I would use the world view in this way.

[It’s a novel. Hmm, I guess I'll have to make some changes to your life record first.]

"Yeah, well. You can talk about that later, but let’s talk about the novel I’m writing. It’s quite interesting."

[Do you really have to tell me that? I'm the principal?]

"Is there a law against talking about novels to the principal?"

[I think it would be better to consult with a teacher who majors in the subject.]

"It looks like you forgot the settings. There is no Korean language teacher at our school."

[There are no Korean teachers, but there are teachers who like novels. For example, Teacher Yang—]

"Teacher Yang said that there is no one who has read as many 'novels' as the principal. From old stories to recently popular stories. They say you are an expert in all genres."

[The worldview feels strongly disturbed by your utterance.]

[The world view cannot interpret your utterance.]

Light sparks began to fly in the air.

The principal stared at me for a moment, hesitated, and then answered.

[I do like reading. So?]

"I'm stuck in the development of the novel I was writing, so I'd like to ask for some advice."

[Didn't you say it was a career issue earlier...]

"It's a novel career issue."

[…What is the novel about?]

"It's a novel called 'Infinite Prison Guard'."

[It's a title that has a high probability of being uninteresting.]

"To put it briefly, it is a story about the main character attending 'Philia Hunter Academy' and fighting against demons."

[Oh, that's a familiar school name.]

"Anyway, the main character of the novel is Kim Dokja."

[Isn't that your name?]

"It's just the main character's name and it has nothing to do with me. What kind of crazy writer would write a main character under his own name?"

[So what does it mean that the development has been blocked?]

"Suddenly the characters started moving without my intention."

[Ho, that's a writer's concern.]

"It's not a metaphor, it's real. In particular, 'Teacher Yang' is very different from the 'Teacher Yang' I set."

[The worldview feels strongly disturbed by your speech!]

The probability aftereffects have become more serious than before. The principal's expression hardened as the aftermath seemed to pressurize the entire principal's office.

"Do I really have to say that it looks like someone else has possessed her…?"

[The worldview cannot interpret your utterance!]

[The probability of this worldview are starting to explode!]

"The principal even brought up a possibility that didn’t exist in the story—"

Just as the storm that rose up in an instant was about to cover the entire principal's office, a powerful explosion exploded from the principal's entire body.

For a moment, the surrounding probability faded away with a dull sound. The worldview that was watching me was moving away.

The 'principal’s office' he built withstood the probability of the 'worldview'.

[The 'Principal's Office' area is temporarily outside the control of the universe.]

The principal, whose complexion was somewhat paler than before, sighed.

[I really can't beat you.]

"Can I tell you my real concern now?"

[Do whatever you want. Isn’t that why you did this?]

As I looked at the principal shaking his head, I remembered the description I wrote a long time ago.

「A middle-aged man with gray hair waved his hand. A pink Hawaiian shirt with a pineapple on it and ripped jeans.」

Although I only remembered his appearance through description, I was convinced the moment I saw him.

"Are you the 'Mass Production Manufacturer'?"

Then the Mass Production Manufacturer smiled brightly. With the exact expression that only existed in my head.

[Maybe so, maybe not.]

"Yes and no."

I nodded and continued speaking.

"You are the 'Mass Production Manufacturer' from the 1,864th world line and the 'Recycling Center Director' from the 41st world line."

The Mass Production Manufacturer seemed a little surprised and did not respond.

"Have other Constellations been possessed into this world like you? How many people have crossed over?"

[…]

"What is your purpose? Why are you suddenly intervening in this world line?"

Along with the question, I thought of the 'existences from other world lines' I had encountered so far.

Asmodeus owns the 'theater' where the little Kim Dokjas reside.

Shin Yoosung from <Kim Dokja Company>, who possessed Shin Yoosung.

Cheon Inho in the 40th Round was strangely strong.

Yoo Sangah and Lee Gilyoung appeared as Constellations.

Even Uriel became 'Teacher Yang'.

"What are you planning in this 41st Round? If this continues and the probability of the world line becomes distorted—"

[The probability has already been distorted. Not only this world line, but the probability of the entire universe.]

As he slowly pulled back the curtains by the window, the scenery of the 'Forest of Demons' came into view.

[At the very moment you were born.]

A tone of voice that stimulates all kinds of sinister imagination.

I asked back reflexively.

"What does that mean?"

Just by exchanging a few words, the spark area was growing again.

The Mass Produced Manufacturer said, blinking lazily.

[You probably have a lot of questions. But I only intend to answer three questions.]

As I watched the sparks encroaching on the bottom of the room once again, I chose questions over and over again in my mind.

And then I opened my mouth.

"Why did you become the 'Recycling Center Director'?"

[You can only ask three questions. Do you really want to ask that?]

Of course, there were many other things I wanted to ask:

Why did the Constellations gather for this 41st Round?

Are you aware of the existence of 'Representative Kim Dokja'?

What is Asmodeus' purpose?

How can I see the end of this world?

Where is the 'Demon King of Salvation'?

But some questions would be resolved in time, some I would have to figure it out on my own, and some I wasn't sure I would ever get an answer to.

"If I choose an answer that is easy for you, shouldn’t you spend less on probability? Please answer. Why did you become 'Director of the Recycling Center'?"

So the first question I chose was this.

[You really haven’t changed.]

The mass-produced manufacturer laughed slightly.

As if I was right, the progress of the Probability Sparks encroaching on the room slowed slightly.

[You probably know that I like old tales.]

I nodded.

[Among them, there is one tale I particularly like. A story about a man.]

It was a story I also knew well.

A story that started in the subway and ended in the subway. The story of a star who sacrifices himself to protect the world of his loved ones.

It was the story of a man who loved stories so much that he became eternity within them.

[It is a story called 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.]

I took a silent breath. I had no idea that that title would come out of the mouth of the mass-produced manufacturer.

I bit my lip and asked again.

"Is bringing Uriel related to that story?"

Now that I think about it, that was the second question.

The Mass Produced Manufacturer shrugged his shoulders and answered.

[I just suggested it. It is by her will that she came.]

"Uriel is not a tool in the scenario."

[No one should be a tool for the scenario. These are truly pretty and fleeting words.]

"…"

[As you probably already know, we are merely actors playing our respective roles in the vast Star Stream. The only thing that flows is the story. The Scribe of Eden understood his role better than anyone else. That's why I came here to protect you.]

I couldn't say anything.

[You too can choose like her. The first option is to do nothing.]

You don't have to do anything.

This is what Uriel also said.

[You can stay at this school and delay graduation. You will have a wonderful time as a student with your peers. Participating in club activities, joining the student council, studying for exams, and eating lunch.]

"That can’t be the ending."

[Can you really say that’s the case?]

"Not everything that looks like a road can be a road."

A road that is not a road.

That was advice that the Mass Production Manufacturer once left to Kim Dokja.

「Please choose your path carefully. Sometimes what seems like a road may not be a road.」

The mass-produced manufacturer smiled brightly, as if recalling memories of that time.

[Is that so? In the past, I used to say things like that.]

As before, he took out a cigarette from his chest and lit it. There was an unknown longing buried in the hazy smoke.

[Now I think 'a road that is not a road' is also not a bad thing.]

Why did he change his mind?

I remembered the '■■' of the mass production type manufacturer. Clearly, he had reached his own conclusion then.

[This is because I thought that not every story necessarily needs an ending.]

If for a moment I felt like his eyes were worried about me, was it my delusion?

[At least you are safe if you stay at this school. The same goes for your colleagues. If only you could fool yourself.]

"…"

[Did you forget? The protagonist of 『Infinite Prison Guard』 also made a similar choice.]

I thought of Ma Hyunsung, who repeated the world forever to protect a single save file.

[Either clear this scenario, or stay in this scenario… In the end, destruction will come to you. The end of this world is certain. It's just a difference in speed. You can make this your home. As we face a leisurely and peaceful destruction.]

"Like Reinheit in Paradise?"

[Yes, like Reinheit in Paradise.]

"You just said that was your first option."

[That's right.]

"From now on, please tell me about the third option first. I will definitely choose that option."

The Mass Produced Manufacturer laughed silently and looked out the window. The setting sun beyond the forest was reflected in his eyes, which were as distant as the night sky.

His voice, tinged with sunset, was strangely lonely.

[Do you know why the stars liked Kim Dokja's story?]

"I do not know."

[It's because the choices Kim Dokja makes give us expectations.]

My face and Kim Dokja's face were shining through the window covered in sunset. We have always chosen something with this face.

"It wasn't a choice made to get attention from the stars."

[Maybe so. Anyway, Kim Dokja showed the outcome he sought with his shameless attitude.]

"..."

[At that moment, even though all the stars were looking at different scenery, they belonged to a single story. That was a really great thing.]

I thought of Kim Dokja's soul, which was split into tens or hundreds of thousands of pieces and scattered.

I too was one of them.

[But then Kim Dokja disappeared and something went awry. Now, 'one dream' no longer exists in this universe.]

The Mass Produced Manufacturer slowly turned his head and looked at me. An unknown longing flickered in his deeply sunken eyes.

For a moment, I felt like I knew why he was here. I felt like I knew why he brought Uriel and why he and all the readers took refuge here.

[This time, please don’t end that dream arbitrarily.]

The mass production type manufacturer.

He is a star who loves the oldest tale in this world.

Using all his coins, the Constellation recreated the ■■ he dreamed of in the story of 'Kim Dokja'.

[Just like your brother did.]

He wants the 'one and only Kim Dokja' to be revived once again.

Tsutsutsutsu.

The pressure on the principal's office was slowly growing stronger. There was no time anymore.

It was time to ask the last question.

"Where is the Demon King of Salvation?"

He glanced out the window once again.

[He is a body consecrated to the scenario. You can never meet the way you want.]

"Then—"

Tsutsutsu, a sound followed by a storm enveloped the entire principal's office.

[The world view is staring at the 'principal’s office'.]

As the world's rules fell into place, I once again became a part of 'Philia Hunter Academy'.

The being who had previously been the 'mass production type producer' was looking at me.

[You have earned all the points.]

He is the principal of this school.

And I was his student.

[Are you going to take the graduation exam?]

Beyond the window, in the forest of demons, a probability afterstorm was rumbling. Students who realized that the forest's behavior was strange were seen leaving the dormitory one by one.

Among them were my colleagues.

Someone had a solemn look in their eyes, and someone was holding a weapon with a nervous look.

Looking down from up high, they all really looked like actors in a play.

"You already know my answer, don’t you?"

The principal nodded.

[Your brother is waiting for you.]

Along with the principal's words, an explosion was heard from afar.

[You have earned all the points required for the graduation exam.]

[The principal has approved your graduation exam.]

['Graduation exam' begins.]

The forest was crying. The ground trembled and a huge number of demons were seen running across the border of the forest.

[The energy of great demons stirs in the 'Forest of Demons'.]

Moans and screams heard from everywhere. A message was heard in the air along with the sound of weapons exploding.

[The Great Demon, the '73rd Demon King' has descended!]

My brother was calling me.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 770 Episode 34 Sibling (1)

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When I was young, I was an only child and begged my parents to give me a younger sibling.

Every time that happened, my parents would laugh or make a sad face as if they were in trouble, or they would say with a half-joking face, "Actually, you had a hidden older brother."

「"Where is my brother?"」

「"Your brother became a star."」

Looking back now, I wonder if that was some kind of metaphor.

My father added this with a somewhat solemn expression.

「"Hakhyun, you don't have to share the same blood to be family. There's no need to attach too much meaning to blood. That's also an illusion."」

As expected, looking back, he was just saying that raising me alone would be difficult, but there was no way my young self could have understood that.

「"What kind of history we are connected to is more important. That alone is enough to make us a family."」

My father’s words sounded like a famous line from a boy’s cartoon. So, like an extra in a shonen's cartoon, I said, "Oh!"

And now, more than a dozen years later, I was once again thinking about my father’s famous line.

"Dokja-ssi!"

Even though I was called not by my name but by my brother's name, I felt strongly overwhelmed for a moment.

"Everyone stand back!"

The demons that had come were biting the students in a mess.

My colleagues were at the center of it all.

"Sein-ssi! Dansu ahjussi! This way! Avoid this way! Ilhoon-ssi! Seyeon-ssi!”

Killer King and Cha Yerin heard my voice and immediately joined the group.

"Kim Dokja, why did the exam suddenly start?"

"When did you tell me it started? Please follow me!"

There were over a hundred demons that flooded the entrance of the forest.

If you deal with them right away, you will be eaten without leaving a single bone behind.

"Aaaahhh!"

"Run! Run!"

Not only were the numbers large, but the rank of demons was also formidable.

At least grade 5.

Students who had lost limbs were running away from the feast of monsters that looked as strong as Viscount Demons.

[You can take shelter inside the 'school'.]

I saw scared incarnations running into the school. They were the ones who gave up on the scenario due to the pressure of the demon species.

[If you evacuate into the 'school', you will automatically be eliminated from the 'Graduation Exam'.]

At the school, 'teachers' including Uriel, Waryong, and the Mass Production Type Producer are waiting.

Perhaps they will protect the students who ran away.

I could see Uriel watching from afar. It seemed like she wanted to come this way right away. But there is something that holds her back, and she will not be able to defy it.

I looked back at my companions.

"Let’s go into the forest."

Normally, there would have been a sound of panic, but none of the group members made a sound of pain.

Rather, they nodded as if they had been waiting.

Suddenly, an old memory came to mind.

Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi were whining because they couldn't catch a single groundhog, and Cha Yerin and Killer King were having a hard time fighting Guardians of the Darkness.

Boom!

The fist swung by Kyung Sein crushed the head of the grade 5 demon species that was charging at her.

Now that the restrictions on skill use had been lifted, the party members were running wild and beating up the demons to their heart's content.

From afar, Kyung Sein waved her hand.

"What are you doing? Come quickly, Dokja-ssi!"

If they want to live, they just have to go back to school. Nevertheless, no one in the group backed down.

"I will clear a path."

They have decided.

[The forces you belong to are united.]

[A new story begins to germinate!]

I also stood next to them and swung my sword.

The 'Unbreakable Faith' left by Han Sooyoung and Kim Dokja shone brightly.

The [Way of the Wind] condensed at the tip of the sword swirled, and the blades of wind scattered in all directions.

Gyaaaaaaaaa!

In 『Infinite Prison Guard』, this 'demon flooding' incident is a kind of entry event. Once you break through the initial waves of demons and enter the forest, it is rare to deal with demons of that size until you encounter the great demons.

[You have entered 'Inside the Demon Forest'.]

We soon broke through the demon troops and entered the forest.

[Scenario content has been updated!]

**<Main Scenario #20 – Graduation>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: SSS+

Clear conditions: Enter the 'source' of the Demon Forest and defeat the strong demon '73rd Demon King' at the source.

Time limit: 3 days

Reward: Fragment of the Oldest Dream, ???

Failure: —

As expected, the scenario content has been updated.

The eyes of the group members widened as they confirmed the clear conditions.

"This… isn’t right, is it?"

As soon as they saw the words '73rd Demon King', each member of the group began to imagine sinister thoughts in their own way.

The 73rd Demon King.

The '10th main scenario' that Kim Dokja and his companions faced. On the top floor of the Dark Castle, the party completed the scenario by killing Kim Dokja, who became the 73rd Demon King.

Killer King opened his mouth.

"Rather than one of us becoming the 73rd Demon King, it could be a scenario where we defeat the '73rd Demon King' who already exists. That was the original development in the Book of Revelation."

"Then that would be a relief…"

Is it really fortunate that such a development unfolds?

For a moment, I thought about the '73rd Demon King' who would be strong at the source of the forest. Unfortunately, I didn't have time to indulge in sentimentality for long.

"We need to split into teams."

"Here? It would be dangerous—"

"If we stick together, our survival rate will be high for a while. However, group action may be disadvantageous in this 'forest'."

Cha Yerin seemed to immediately understand what I was saying.

I sent a message to Cha Yerin through [group chat].

—Yerin-ssi, please move with the rest of the group. I have somewhere else to go.

—Is it because of item farming?

I nodded.

—Yes. Do you remember?

—I roughly know Ma Hyunsung’s exclusive farming route.

Treasures to fight against demons are buried in this forest. Some of them were buried by teachers, while others were used by previous students.

There are a total of 8 farming routes for items.

I was planning to choose route A, which was the most difficult of them all.

—Yerin, please take route B. Do you remember the route?

—Yes. I remember.

As expected, she is a person with the characteristic of being 'Literature Girl (S)'.

As long as I somehow collected the items that could be obtained from routes A and B, I had a chance of winning no matter what demon appeared.

In 『Infinite Prison Guard』, didn't Ma Hyunsung defeat the Great Demon in the same way?

Now, in my head, the 'Demon Forest Strategy' practiced by Ma Hyunsung was intact.

—But would you mind if I went alone?

—It's okay. It's your novel.

I was fortunate that Cha Yerin was a reader of 『Infinite Prison Guard』.

"I have a few items that I need to farm alone. Everyone else, please follow Seyeon-ssi. Let’s meet again at the checkpoint in an hour. Seyeon-ssi will give a detailed briefing."

The companions seemed to think I had some kind of clever idea, so they kept looking back and disappeared into the forest, following Cha Yerin.

Cha Yerin's B route is a relatively safe route among Ma Hyunsung's previous farming routes. If all four of them go together, they will be safe unless they encounter a marquis-level demon.

The problem is on my side.

I smiled bitterly and took out a cigarette of 'Mana Tobacco' from my pocket. I had stolen something that Yoo Joonghyuk had kept on the rooftop. As soon as the fire was lit, thick smoke rose.

I opened my mouth, staring at the slowly spreading smoke.

"Why don’t you stop and come out?"

Sending the party to route B wasn't just because of 'item farming'.

How much time had passed since I opened my mouth?

Something flew in as if it had been waiting for me from deep in the bush.

It was a bomb filled with 'poisonous fog'.

Push-shu-shu, accompanied by a sound, particles of pitch-black poisonous fog instantly surrounded the entire area.

"Catch him!"

Incarnations wearing masks popped out from all over the bushes.

A typical pattern of poisoning with poisonous fog and then attacking.

Squawk!

Five or six weapons flooded into the place where I was, but none of them could touch me.

[The exclusive skill 'Smoke Man' is being activated.]

Kim Kyungsik’s exclusive skill, [Smoke Man].

I used the cigarette smoke I had already smoked to escape outside the spray radius of the fog and hid myself among the bushes.

"What? Wasn’t he here a little while ago?"

The total number of incarnations that appeared was nine.

The panicked guys kept looking around.

Let’s take a look at who the guys chasing me are.

[Exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

As soon as I activated [Character List], information about them quickly appeared before my eyes. Judging by their characteristics and potential, they were not very strong.

What they have in common is that they all belong to the same 'force'.

「Rat.」

I've felt it since the poisonous fog pattern, but is it him again this time?

"Find it! He has 'Kim Dokja Fragments'!"

The purpose he was pursuing was as expected.

"Both Gu Seonah and Ye Hyunwoo collected them and became stronger. If we just eliminate that guy and collect the fragments, we can become as strong as the guys from Class A."

On the surface, this scenario represents the 'graduation exam' of 『Infinite Prison Guard』, but the inside story is a bit different.

The Constellations of the Zodiac, readers from all over, and even the Recycling Center Director—know what the hidden purpose of this scenario is.

「The key to this scenario is the collection of 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.」

How many more readers will die this time?

[The Constellation 'Plague-Carrying Rat' is looking for you.]

At the Constellation's command, students began wandering around looking for me. In the past, I would have run away, but things are different now.

I am the representative of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Now it was enough to fight against the Constellations of the Misreading Association.

"Is it this way?"

"Damn rats, the players…"

The problem is that the forces that came together are not one.

From the 'snake cutting off its tail' to the 'dog throwing itself into the flames'.

As students belonging to the rat, snake, and dog groups appeared, the nearby forest quickly became crowded.

"Find him! Find Kim Dokja!"

No matter how strong I am now, it wasn't easy to fight against that number.

Since there were no hidden items nearby anyway, I was wondering if I should retreat at this point—

Skag.

One student's head fell off.

[Current remaining graduates: 186]

The number of remaining graduates appeared in the hologram window in the air.

[Current remaining graduates: 184]

The number of survivors decreases in real time.

"W-Who are you—"

The scared students instinctively took up arms.

They swung them around. However, the weapon only split the air and could not cut anything.

Sugagak.

When a student's head fell again, the terrified students began to scatter.

"Ugh, wow! It’s him! It’s Kim Dokja!"

I didn't do it.

[Your notoriety is growing!]

The student who cried out my name immediately lost his voice. It was so fast that I couldn't even see it properly.

[Current remaining graduates: 152]

As more than thirty students were slaughtered in an instant, the Constellations' voices were heard in the air.

[The Constellation 'Rat That Brings Plague' shouts out what kind of thing is this!]

[The Constellation 'Snake Cutting Its Tail' spits out flames of anger!]

[The Constellation 'Dog That Threw Itself Into The Flames' is rolling over flames and is indignant!]

After a while, a demon species appeared through the blood-soaked bushes.

I couldn't believe it.

Just one demon slaughtered thirty incarnations in an instant? And the descendants of the <Zodiac>?

[The Constellation 'Rat That Brings Plague'… ]

[The Constellation 'Snake Cutting Its Taill'… ]

Despite the indignant voices of the Constellations, the demon species was not intimidated at all. Instead, he just boredly dug his ears and muttered.

[It’s noisy.]

With that one word, the Constellations in the air became quiet. And after a while.

[The Constellation 'Rat That Brings Plague' is astonished.]

[The Constellation 'Snake Cutting Its Tail' opens its eyes.]

[The Constellation 'Dog That Threw Itself Into The Flames' questions whether this is different from the promise!]

Even the Constellations of the Chinese zodiac are entities that need to take a step back.

I belatedly remembered the second floor of 'Zodiac Ball'.

I forgot about it for a while.

Besides the <Zodiac> guys, there are Constellations that are interested in the 'Kim Dokja fragments'.

They are Constellations that desire all the stories of this <Star Stream>.

[Warning. 'Advanced demons' have appeared in the area!]

The Gourmet Association.

Those damn gourmet experts took part in this scenario wearing the guise of 'advanced demons'.

[The only ones who don't even go to the farewell. There definitely seemed to be a large number.]

While a high-level demon was licking the blood from his arm, another guy appeared.

[Hmm? What? Did you miss it?]

[I lost him. He’s a quick guy.]

The moment its gaze passed over the surrounding bushes, a shiver ran down my spine.

Are those things called 'high-level demons'?

This is ridiculous. Even with all my might, it was impossible to hunt down that one guy.

It wasn't even one.

Even though I thought I should run away right away, my body did not move easily. It wasn't out of fear. It was because I saw a weapon in the hands of a newly appeared high-level demon.

[It's a shame, the guy with this spear was pretty tasty.]

The guy who muttered that was holding a familiar looking spear in his hand.

「Weolgeuk.」

It was Yoo Joonghyuk's main weapon in the 41st Round.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

# 771 Episode 34 Sibling (2)

My body was shaking without me knowing.

The only thought that dominated my mind was to immediately slaughter the demons in front of me and steal their spear.

What stopped me was the [Transmission] that came to my ear.

—Author.

When I looked back in shock, I saw Ji Eunyu curled up like me.

—Stay still.

Ji Eunyu shook her head desperately and added.

—I know it’s Yoo Joonghyuk’s spear. But that’s Yoo Joonghyuk’s 'lost spear'.

Belatedly, the series of events that had occurred so far came to mind one after another.

From the moment he first entered the 'Recycling Center', Yoo Joonghyuk had lost all of his items. The 'battle boots' he was wearing right now were from the 'Zodiac Race' prize.

—The 'Master of the Spear' that that high-ranking demon dealt with must be someone else.

What Ji Eunyu said was right.

I managed to sigh and calm down my boiling anger.

Ji Eunyu’s soft palm was placed on my shoulder.

—Why is the writer acting so uncharacteristically? Did you have any abnormal condition?

I don't know either.

Maybe I unconsciously felt indebted to Yoo Joonghyuk.

Maybe it's because I promised to write his story.

I caught a glimpse of the story and only responded with the shape of my mouth.

I said, 'I guess I just lost my mind for a moment. Thank you!'

—You know you can never win now, right?

'I know.'

Again, it would have been suicidal to engage in an all-out war with the upper-class demons possessed by the 'Gourmet Association'. At the very least, it would be nice to have an item exclusive to 『Infinite Prison Guard』.

[Hmm?]

Just then, a high-level demon turned his head and began to approach this way.

Cold sweat formed down my back.

When I looked to the side, Ji Eunyu also had a hardened expression.

I thought about the number of times [Smoke Man] could be used in my head.

Should I burn ‘Mana Tobacco’ right now? If I attract attention, will I be able to buy Ji Eunyu time to run away?

The moment he approached us right in front of us.

[Hey, a large fragment was detected.]

The voice of another high-ranking demon holding the Wolgeuk was heard.

The demon, whose expression changed, turned around and asked.

[Which one?]

[West.]

[Let’s go right away, it might be that guy called 'Kim Dokja'.]

Only after they disappeared did we manage to breathe a sigh of relief.

Ji Eunyu touched her chest and opened her mouth.

"I was surprised because I thought they were coming for us."

"It’s not a safe situation yet."

"Why? I think they’ve gone far enough—"

"Those guys must have gone to other students."

In this scenario, the characters who can be called 'big fragments' are determined.

Currently, the expected number of people is two.

Ji Eunyu nodded and said as if she knew who those two were.

"It would be Gu Seonah or Ye Hyunwoo."

"Maybe so."

"You’re not planning on going to rescue them, are you?"

"…"

"Writer."

[The world view is looking at you.]

Ji Eunyu, startled by the faint spark, changed her conversation back to [Transmission].

—I forgot. You can just answer with your mouth. Because I have the [Lip Reading] skill.

When I nodded, Ji Eunyu continued speaking.

—Right now, finding one reader is not the problem. And Goo Seonah and Ye Hyunwoo are not people who share the same views as us.

'They are also ordinary readers.'

—There is no way ordinary readers would have collected so many 'Kim Dokja fragments'.

'That.'

I was about to say something when I suddenly raised my head and looked at Ji Eunyu.

Fragments of Kim Dokja.

Have I ever told Ji Eunyu any details about it?

—How could I not know when the situation has come to this point?

Ji Eunyu sighed lightly and continued.

—I heard it a little bit from Meihouwang. It is said that fragments of the 'Oldest Dream' are scattered throughout this world.

Meihouwang. Certainly, for a constellation of that level, it would not be strange to know the story about the 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.

—Are you also collecting the fragments?

I hesitated and nodded. There was no reason to lie to Ji Eunyu here. However, when the truth was revealed, a slight fear arose.

—Why are you doing that?

'That is...?'

—Isn’t that the only way to bring Kim Dokja back to life if we collect them?

'Do you know how to obtain Kim Dokja Fragments?'

—It’s not like the author is going around killing readers to collect their souls. Didn't you collect the dead readers or kill and collect the monsters that ate the readers?

When I nodded, Ji Eunyu added as if she knew that would happen.

—Then there is no problem. They say the more you collect, the stronger you become? Because it's safer to be in the hands of the author than to be in the hands of bad people.

Those were words of gratitude. These were words of gratitude, so I couldn't say thank you carelessly.

—Because I know what kind of person the author is. However, if other readers are collecting, the story is a little different.

'Those people are not ones who would kill someone to collect their fragments.'

—Author. You haven't forgotten what the 'first scenario' we experienced is, right?

'…'

—I know the author trusts his readers, but those who have survived so far have experienced at least one murder. The same goes for me.

I know. Of those who have survived so far, no one has survived unscathed.

However, just because someone committed a certain sin, I did not want to judge their entire person based on that sin alone.

'The people I saw, Ye Hyunwoo and Goo Seonah, were never bad people.'

I thought of the little readers I saw in Asmodeus's 'Theater'.

'They're just people who like novels.'

Pure eyes gathered in one place just because they were curious about the next story.

'If it weren't for them, I wouldn't have been able to pay the overdue rent for a single room. I wouldn't have been able to eat regular meals, and I wouldn't have been able to continue writing. I wouldn't have been able to continue my dream. I wouldn't have been able to write Han Sooyoung's manuscript. Therefore—'

I owe them my life.

'I will save those people.'

Ji Eunyu looked at me like that and pursed her lips several times before sighing deeply.

—If you say so, I also received a salary from them.

'Then there's another reason to save them.'

—You’re not going right away, are you?

There is a reason why I chose this route.

'This route?'

—You need to find 'Rotania’s sword hilt' and 'Bilton’s scabbard'.

I was dazed for a moment and then asked.

'How does the editor know that?'

—Isn’t it more weird that I don’t know?

'Have you read 'Infinite Prison Guard'? But that was written before I signed a contract with the editor.'

Ji Eunyu shot back with a slightly red face, probably because she was angry.

—Of course I saw it all. What editor doesn’t read novels written by contracted writers?

As I was rummaging through the nearby forest with a grumpy Ji Eunyu, I found a tree trunk with an unfamiliar mark engraved on it.

We exchanged looks and started digging under the tree trunk.

How much dirt was dug up like that?

We found an old skeleton arm and the broken hilt of the sword it held.

'The hilt of Saint Lotania.'

A weapon used by graduates of the 'Filia Hunter Academy' in the past.

As expected, it was buried exactly where I had written it down.

"It only has a handle. I guess someone took the sheath."

"Let’s take this with us."

The final combination item that can be obtained from 'Ma Hyunsung Farming Route A' is 'Holy Sword Raven Ringer'.

The Raven Ringer was an item with 'holy attributes' that was absolutely necessary to deal with the Great Demon.

We grabbed the hilt of our swords and moved straight toward the direction where the high-level demons had disappeared.

While we were moving, Ji Eunyu and I had a short chat about what happened so far.

—Who knew that I would have to wear a school uniform again?

'That's right.'

—It suits the writer well.

'I guess it suits Cheon Inho better, not me.'

—The face is the author’s.

We also exchanged information about the Chinese Zodiac belonging to each class.

—You fought with incarnations of rats, snakes, and dogs?

'To be exact, I didn't fight, but the Gourmet Association wiped them out.'

—Well, it turned out that way too. But my forces… So, I don’t think the monkeys are particularly interested in this scenario. In the first place, I think Meihouwang applied to participate just because he was bored.

But. Not everyone in the Chinese zodiac is serious about this ball.

In particular, the 'Monkey' faction does not have any merit in participating in the 'Zodiac Ball'. Even from the Recycling Center's perspective, it will be difficult if the constellation Son Wukong descends directly...

—But other <zodiac signs> will have a slightly different stance. Especially the guys who attacked the author. And the 'tiger' and 'cow' sides seemed sincere.

I guess so.

The status of those who have been eliminated by me in previous scenarios, such as tigers, rats, and snakes, has been greatly reduced.

In this scenario, unless we somehow make up for it, our existence as a constellation will be in jeopardy.

'The same goes for the Gourmet Association guys.'

The Gourmet Association will be watching the struggles of such great constellations.

The fact that they participated in the scenario as 'high-level demons' probably means that they are prepared to end this scenario in a tragedy.

Of course, as long as I'm around, things won't go as they think.

"Ji Eunyu."

"Yes."

We stopped at the signal and hid ourselves among the surrounding bushes.

The sound of the surrounding forest being torn apart.

The sharp crackling sound of a weapon was heard through the red burning leaves.

Someone was fighting nearby.

However, the surge of magical energy felt every time a single clatter sounded was unusual.

"Stop it."

A cold voice heard through the thick bloody smell.

"You must be Goo Seonah."

Together with Ji Eunyu, I quickly grasped the situation.

The student council president, Goo Seonah, has her arms crossed with her back to the forest. And there were members of <Kim Dokja Company> who built defenses as if to protect her.

Lee Hyunsung, Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye, Shin Yoosung, and even Jung Heewon.

As expected, the ones putting pressure on them were the two high-ranking demons who had attacked us earlier.

[A lot of delicious-looking guys have gathered.]

The high-level demons, all drooling, rushed forward while simultaneously releasing their attacks.

I wanted to shout at them to run away right away. No, even if I didn't shout, if they felt the intensity of those 'high-level demons' unleashing, they should have run away.

But they didn't run away.

Kaaaaang!

The pitch-black blade wielded by a high-level demon collided with white light and bounced off.

Looking closely, I saw that Goo Seonah and her group were all wearing silver-shining armor and greaves.

I immediately recognized what the item was.

'Holy Messenger Set.'

Anti-Asmodian standard equipment that can be obtained from 'Ma Hyunsung's Farming D Route'.

I was already wondering how they got that—

[Currently, the 『Infinite Prison Guard』 collaboration item is being sold in the 'Dokkaebi Bag'.]

I opened the 'Dokkaebi Bag' with a feeling of wonder.

| |
|---|
| * Holy Messenger Set — In Stock 0 |

It was absurd.

No, does this make sense now?

…

* Commercial flare — 1

* Top quality holy water — 2

* Holy Sword Light Wish — Inventory 0

Even Light Wish, which was considered the famous sword of 'Filia Hunter Academy' along with the holy sword 'Raybringer', was sold.

I belatedly looked through the list to purchase the items I needed. But unfortunately, cost-effective items were almost sold out.

The items that were still in stock were at such exorbitant prices that I couldn't afford them at the moment.

Of course, it doesn't mean that I can't buy it if I decide to do so, but as the incarnation of the 'Demon King of Salvation', the price is simply unbearable.

"We got hit."

I never thought I would be stabbed in the back like this.

I can't believe the damn dokkaebis would have released related items as products. It was a carelessness caused by my arrogance of knowing the worldview.

Even the holy sword in question, 'Light Wish', was held in the hands of student council president Goo Seonah.

[The item 'Light Wish' increases the morale of the party.]

From 'Holy Messenger Set' to 'Light Wish'. It was definitely a combination that could deal with even high-level demons.

It was unfair. No, what am I supposed to do for a living if I am already at a disadvantage and am deprived of privileges as the original author like this?

If the worldview was illegally stolen and all the items were taken away—

[Someone has purchased a 'collaboration item'.]

[The 'original work usage fee' has been paid to you.]

There is no benefit to the original author...

[Someone has purchased a 'collaboration item'.]

[The 'original work usage fee' has been paid to you.]

I quietly glared at the message that appeared before my eyes.

[Someone has purchased a 'collaboration item'.]

[The 'original work usage fee' has been paid to you.]

No matter how many times I rubbed my eyes and checked, it was the same.

It was definitely true.

[The 'original work usage fee' has been paid to you.]

I thought as I opened the 'dokkaebi bag' once again.

[Would you like to check the 'original work usage fee' deposited?]

How much was that item from earlier?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 772 Episode 34 Sibling (3)

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[150,000 coins were obtained as a fee for using the original work.]

As I watched the coins coming in in real time, the corners of my mouth twitched without me realizing it.

Come to think of it, Kim Dokja also made money by selling Han Sooyoung's novels.

Did Kim Dokja feel this way at that time?

—Author. Why are you grinning?

'It's no big deal.'

I felt strange.

This is because I had no idea that the <Star Stream> would settle something like 'original work royalties'.

In reality, I only signed a lot of contracts for various things, but I almost never received proper royalties from others using the original work...

—Is it good?

When I raised my head, I saw the shadow of a dokkaebi swaying high in the dark sky.

—Do you like it? This time I paid special attention.

I smiled bitterly.

As expected, Bihyung had a hand in it.

—I have also completed discussions with the 'Recycling Center Director'. Instead of borrowing your world view, pay you an incentive...

'Thank you, but shouldn't you have gotten my permission before using it?'

—Huh? What are you talking about? I got permission.

Allow? No, it's my work. Who on earth did you get permission from?

At that moment, someone's name came to mind. Anyone except me can sell my copyright without permission.

—Your friend sponsor said before that he could exchange this for coins and signed a contract with us.

This damn sponsor.

—Anyway, that’s how it happened, so cheer up. I'm going again.

'Wait! Is that the answer? What else did my sponsor sell?'

Unfortunately, there was no reply from Bihyung.

I took a quick breath and applied it to the situation. There is no way it can be done this way. If this is his plan, I have no choice but to use it to the best of my ability.

I quickly purchased items that I could use right now from the 'Dokkaebi’s Bag'.

[You have completed purchasing the item.]

At that moment, a change occurred in the battlefield.

[Kahahahaha! This is fun!]

Meanwhile, the number of high-level demons jumping into the battlefield increased.

There were two people I cherished, but now there are four, five, no... six?

[Hey, let’s eat delicious food together.]

Currently, the core weapons of Goo Seonah's team are the 'Holy Lion Set' and the holy sword worn by Goo Seonah herself, 'Light Wish'.

The 'Holy Messenger Set' was a supply specialized for defense, and the 'Light Wish' was a kind of buff item.

In other words, there was no item that could cause damage to high-level demons.

"What are these demons ? Why don’t they die!"

Kim Namwoon, who was embarrassed, repeatedly swung his knife, but unfortunately, the attribute of [Black Flame] was unable to deliver an effective blow to the high-level demon.

To make matters worse, the durability of the 'Holy Messenger Set' was slowly decreasing. As the high-level demons joined forces in an instant and poured out repeated attacks, cracks began to appear in various places in the 'Holy Lion Armor' that could not withstand the blows.

"It’s hard to hold on any longer!"

Goo Seonah bit her lip at Lee Hyunsung’s shout. It was time to make a decision. Will she sacrifice them and run away, or will she reveal all her might and fight the demons?

Needless to say, it was the latter for me. That was because, although they were at a disadvantage in terms of power, they were not absolutely inferior.

Above all, her team had Jung Heewon, the 'Judge of Destruction'.

'Judge of Destruction' is a trait that exerts absolute power against monsters.

Since 'advanced demons' also fall into the category of monsters, it was naturally right to actively hire Jung Heewon at this point.

"Jung Heewon. Forward.”

As expected, Goo Seonah put Jung Heewon forward.

"Yes."

At Goo Seonah's command, Jung Heewon, wearing the leader's armband, stepped forward.

I felt sick watching Jung Heewon obediently listen to her, but I guess this will solve the crisis.

As long as the rest, led by Jung Heewon, who activated [Time of Judgment], provide good assistance—

"Everyone else goes to the 'source'."

What?

"Chairman, no! Then—"

"Lee Hyunsung. This is the best."

"I can’t leave my colleagues behind. Then Heewon-ssi—"

As expected, in the 41st round, Lee Hyunsung was Lee Hyunsung.

But Goo Seonah’s voice was cold.

"It’s an order."

Goo Seonah made her choice. She said that she would give up Jung Heewon instead of quickly killing the 73rd Demon King.

It was a choice that I could not understand at all.

Jung Heewon is a damage dealer who is effective until the final battle of the scenario. Even if you think about it economically, it was never a card to be discarded here.

Then a thought occurred to me.

[The exclusive skill 'Character List' is activated!]

Character: Jung Heewon

Potential: S

Core settings: Leading team (S+), Kendo club (A+)

Description: A being responsible for class A's justice. She basically follows the student council president's orders, but subconsciously has an aversion to her orders.

She sometimes has a habit of looking blankly out the window as if she is looking for something.

Only then did I understand why Goo Seonah abandoned Jung Heewon.

Is it. Did she decide that if she was someone she couldn't control, it would be better to leave her here?

Jung Heewon, clutching the sword I gave her, 'Mikazuki Munechika', spoke in a voice full of determination.

"You go first, Chairman."

[Character Jung Heewon's characteristic 'Leader (S+)' is strongly activated!]

"Thank you, leader."

Kim Namwoon, who lightly tapped her on the shoulder, moved first, followed by Lee Jihye.

Lee Hyunsung, who hesitated, closed his eyes tightly and turned back.

"I'm sorry. Please come back."

I wondered if that was a scene that made sense.

Only Shin Yoosung lingered until the end, unable to easily leave her place.

"Ahhh."

The moment Shin Yoosung, who was looking at Jung Heewon with a helpless expression, stretched out her hand.

Tsutsutsu.

With a light spark, the light in Shin Yoosung's eyes went out. Afterwards, the child started following Goo Seonah like a mechanical doll.

This made it clear.

Goo Seonah has the skill to control 'characters'.

[Chase them.]

Three high-ranking demons chased after Goo Seonah's team, which was quickly moving away.

However, the remaining three were stranded by Jung Heewon.

There were two guys that didn't follow because they were too lazy. The other one seemed to be interested in Jung Heewon.

[It's not a fragment, but it's still quite interesting.]

He was the one holding Yoo Joonghyuk's spear, 'Wolgeuk'.

[It would be okay for a little entertainment.]

Jung Heewon created magic without saying a word.

Confrontation with high-level demons.

If it was an ordinary incarnation, it wouldn't have been surprising if her mind collapsed the moment she met them, but Jung Heewon was different.

Jung Heewon, who activated [Kendo] in [Demon Slayer], let out a roar and swung her sword towards the upper-class demon.

She lightly swung her weapon and the demon who was struck by the sword laughed.

[The Constellation 'Spear Master' bursts into flames.]

Damn it.

After all, the opponent is that guy.

The 'Spear Master' was a Constellation from the <First Murim> who built his reputation by repeatedly stabbing for hundreds of years.

In other rounds, it was a Historical-grade Constellation, but here he seemed to have been raised to Narrative(?)-grade.

It looks like his status has been boosted by absorbing 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.

Coo coo coo coo coo.

However, since the opponent was wearing the mask of a high-class demon, Jung Heewon had a chance of winning.

[Character 'Jung Heewon' requests the activation of 'Time of Judgment'!]

She is the 'Judge of Destruction'.

As long as [Time of Judgment] is activated, there is a chance of victory no matter who the opponent is.

[Skill activation has been forcibly canceled!]

Jung Heewon, startled, looked up into space.

「Judge of Destruction is a skill that can be activated only when a certain number of Constellations in the channel provide probability.」

However, the Constellations that currently occupy the channel are the <Zodiac> and the Gourmet Association. There was no Constellation that would take her side.

[Where can I get it?]

The storm of magical power that rose from Wolgeuk poured down on Jung Heewon. The 'Holy Lion Armor' worn by Jung Heewon shattered, and sharp magical blades cut through her entire body.

If things continue that way, Jung Heewon will die. There was no time to hesitate.

I activated [Ways of the Wind] with all my might and launched myself at Jung Heewon.

At the same time, explosive spider webs poured out from my entire body.

[What—]

The feet of three demons, including the 'Spear Master', were tied up in [Arachne's Web]. I quickly picked up Jung Heewon, who had fallen through the bushes.

Surprised, Jung Heewon widened her eyes. Soon, venom filled her eyes.

"Let go."

Jung Heewon's body was already in shambles. She was a master at dealing with high-level demons at the head of the group.

"It’s the chairman’s order. I—"

Determination to carry out orders at all costs.

[The person in question is in a state of 'hypnotic instigation'.]

Is that so?

I expected it. Because at this point, the skills to control the characters are set.

'Hypnotic instigation by hypnotist Christina Page'.

Goo Seonah has already murdered other readers and obtained their skills.

There were many ways to awaken [Hypnotic Incitet].

One of them is to awaken people with words more powerful than [Hypnotic Incite].

「With Cheon Inho’s [Incite], it is possible.」

I activated [Incite] without hesitation.

"Heewon-ssi! Wake up!"

[The person in question is under special 'hypnosis'.]

[Stronger 'incite' than usual is needed.]

What?

[Select a 'keyword' that will be of great shock to the person in question.]

Before I knew it, Jung Heewon, with a straight face, thrust the blade of Munechika Mikazuki at my neck.

"Put me down."

I thought about Jung Heewon.

What should I say to shock this person?

「"Inho-ssi, you’re a bit of a strange person. You only say strange things."」

In the main story, the woman who was the sword that protected Kim Dokja.

「"Inho-ssi, how did you become a writer?"」

It already occurred to me that the relationship I had built with her was not short. We hunted ichthyosaurs together, cleared Geumho Station, Chungmuro, and the theater dungeon. We fought against the beggars at Seoul Station and defeated the monsters at Gwanghwamun.

「"Inho-ssi."」

Will those times also become a story one day? How much history must be accumulated before it becomes a story?

I don't know. However, what I remember is only one sentence.

「"Don’t die."」

Jung Heewon always saved me with that one sentence. And now it was my turn to return the sentence.

—Writer! I can't hold on any longer!

There was a figure chasing after me along with Ji Eunyu's screams.

I carried Jung Heewon on my back and reflexively lowered my head. The sharp force of the spear grazed my hair and lodged in the tree.

There was nowhere to run now.

If we don't wake up Jung Heewon now, we will all die here.

So, I feel sorry for Jung Heewon, but here I had no choice but to say something that Jung Heewon would hate to hear.

"Heewon-ssi, I love you!"

This.

I thought it would be okay.

Obviously, she heard something similar on the subway at that time and her expression didn't look good—

[The character 'Jung Heewon' is strongly agitated by your remarks.]

"You… are you suddenly talking nonsense? In this situation…"

Her face was distorted with anger, but Jung Heewon's hypnosis was not broken.

No, this doesn't work?

In the meantime, a high-ranking demon, swinging the moon like a windmill, rushed in.

As I put Jung Heewon down on the floor, I took out 'Unbreakable Faith' and swung it around. There was a heavy sibilant sound and the pain of my wrist being bent.

[You—]

The spear master's eyes widened as he recognized me.

[You are a very large fragment.]

Changgeuk was moving to a state that was difficult to follow with my eyes.

Damn, was I wrong?

I took out one of the items I had purchased earlier from my pocket.

[Use the item 'Commercial Signal Flare'!]

A signal that explodes like a firecracker. I can only hope that my colleagues will check this signal in time.

"Jung Heewon-ssi! Run away!"

I shouted with all my might towards Jung Heewon.

"I will stop this place somehow—"

I desperately activated [Way of the Wind], but it was an unavoidable blow. I felt a sharp spear tearing through the skin of my stomach.

I guess so. Because this is not an enemy I can defeat in my current state.

[Smile?]

Nevertheless, I was smiling while holding on to the pole of his spear.

I thought it was a good thing.

"Jung Heewon-ssi! Quick—"

Why? Jung Heewon had no answer.

I looked back. Jung Heewon was still there. She didn't run away, she just stood there looking at me.

[The character 'Jung Heewon' is greatly shocked.]

It was only at that moment that I realized.

A 'keyword' that can wake up Jung Heewon.

"Ah—"

The moment I saw Jung Heewon's expression, strangely enough, my sponsor came to mind.

「The Demon King of Salvation.」

I now understand why a man who was so inexperienced at saving others was called the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

[The character 'Jung Heewon's' mind temporarily collapses!]

Anyone who is saved by the Demon King will inevitably suffer irreversible damage.

"Don't die, don't die, don't die—"

Jung Heewon, muttering like crazy, staggered closer.

Blood poured out from the skin of my stomach that was stabbed by Changgeuk, and my consciousness gradually faded.

And as my consciousness faded, a strong confidence filled me.

[A Constellation that has not yet revealed its modifier is watching you.]

Jung Heewon will not die.

[The clouded consciousness is partially liberated from the restraints of the body.]

She will suffer injuries so terrible that she will want to die, but she will not die.

[Level 3 of the exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is forcibly activated.]

And there will be a one-sided atonement from the Demon King for this one-sided salvation.

It's reading stories of hurt people.

Read, read, read again.

['First-person Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is activated!]

Finally becoming that person.

"You can't die."

When I opened my eyes, I saw my incarnation body falling.

"No matter what happens, I will definitely save you."

A high-level demon was holding its hand toward my head with greedy eyes.

I moved Jung Heewon's hand and grabbed 'Mikazuki Munechika'.

['Time of Judgment' is activated!]

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation (acting agent)' has agreed to the activation of 'Time of Judgment'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 773 Episode 34 Sibling (4)

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The condition for activating [Time of Judgment] of the Ten Demon Judges is simple.

「Get support from Constellations within the same channel.」

The important thing here is that not all 'Constellations within the same channel' need to agree.

Unlike the 'Judge of Evil's' [Time of Judgment], which does not activate even if only one of the 'Absolute Good' Constellations opposes it, the [Time of Judgment] of the 'Judge of Destruction' can be activated even if only one Constellation agrees.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation (Agent)' has agreed to the activation of the Time of Judgment.]

In other words, [Time of Judgment] can be activated even if there is only one Constellation that agrees within the channel.

[The Constellation 'Rat That Brings Plague' opposes the activation of 'Time of Judgment'!]

[The Constellation 'Snake Cutting Off Its Tail' opposes the activation of 'Time of Judgment'!]

[The Constellation 'Dog That Threw Itself Into The Flames' opposes the activation of 'Time of Judgment'!]

As expected, there was opposition from the beggars. But there is no use in opposing it.

I agreed, so what are you going to do?

['Time of Judgment' begins!]

[The Constellation 'Rat That Brings Plague' opens its eyes!]

[The Constellation 'Snake Cutting Off Its Tail' cannot hide its embarrassment.]

It felt good to see the astonished Constellations, but in fact, it was not a very favorable situation for us.

「The characteristics of the three great judges all have something in common: they borrow the probability of 'Constellations'.」

The judge judges the object on behalf of the will of the Constellations, and the Constellations pay an appropriate probability.

The problem was the probability.

[Currently, there is only one Constellation within the channel that has agreed to the time of judgment.]

[There is insufficient probability.]

[The popularity of 'Time of Judgment' is low.]

Since 'Judgment of Ten Demons' is easy to activate [Time of Judgment], its effect greatly depends on the level or number of people who agree to activate the skill.

In short, right now, Jung Heewon could only borrow the probability of the 'Demon King of Salvation (acting agent)'.

Tsk tsk, tsk tsk.

Surely the skill won't end before she even fights properly?

A high-level demon holding the 'Wolgeuk'—the 'Spear Master' muttered while holding Jung Heewon’s collar.

[Interesting. I never thought there would be an incarnation with the 'judge' trait.]

I spoke to that guy using Jung Heewon's words.

"The level of the Gourmet Association has fallen a lot. They even accept lowly historical-grade like you as 'Gourmet Association' members."

[Are you crazy?]

Looking at his expression, it seemed like I had really touched the point.

I guess so. In fact, these guys are probably not mainstream 'Gourmet Association' members, but rather subcontractors.

For example, this means that these are the people who supply items such as the 'Heart of a 10th Circle Grand Mage' or 'The Right Arm of a Poor Sword Master' that are being eaten up by the Gourmet Association.

[Something like a kid with no background—]

"Are you ignoring the Demon King of Salvation?"

Without hesitation, I put my strength on my back foot. As expected from a born swordsman, her muscle movements were extraordinary.

The 'Spear Master' gave an order as if he was annoyed by the rapidly narrowing distance.

[Block it.]

Two high-level demons who had been loitering in the back stepped forward as if they had been waiting.

[Master of intestines, how dare you order me?]

[I was already planning on eating her!]

One guy seems to have a subspace pouch and appears to be a typical assassin.

And the other one was wearing battle gauntlets, so it was a martial arts style.

It was the assassin who moved first. The guy with his cheeks puffed out like a frog spewed green poisonous smoke, creating a swamp around him.

[Advanced demon 'Filth Addict' activates 'Pollution Zone Lv.10'!]

Filth addict.

Was this guy there too?

This Constellation was originally one of the guys who followed Yoo Joonghyuk like a stalker in the middle rounds of 'Ways of Survival'.

His battle logic is to restrict the opponent's movement by laying down a contaminated area and then shoot the enemy with an extremely poisonous needle to subdue the enemy.

[It looks good to squeeze!]

This guy, who likes to hunt prey with minimal injury, had an eccentric hobby of squeezing out freshly caught prey and eating its contents.

Coincidentally, in 'Ways of Survival', there is a scene where Yoo Joonghyuk subdues that guy.

To explain it in Yoo Joonghyuk style, the method is as follows.

「One, do not step on 'contaminated areas' and use protruding tree trunks as a stepping stone.」

Yoo Joonghyuk's 'combat textbook' is difficult for Cheon Inho to follow.

But what about 'Jung Heewon'?

[You’re a quick guy!]

The moment I jumped into the air to avoid the contaminated area, it shot something out of its mouth again.

「Two, avoid the 'extremely poisonous needle' flying from the air.」

An 'extremely poisonous needle' that cuts off half of your combat ability for 10 minutes with just one hit. It was a key skill that allowed the 'filth addict' with low combat power to maintain his position as a Constellation.

[Exclusive skill 'Way of the Wind' is activated!]

Of course, it doesn't work for me.

The moment the frightened filth addict widened his eyes, I spun around in the air, accelerated, and swung my sword at him.

[Pathetic guy. Go away!]

The one who blocked the sword was a martial arts-style high-level demon who narrowly came forward.

[Advanced demon 'Wingak Taoist' unleashes his power!]

Like the 'Spear Master', he was a Constellation from the <First Murim>.

「A person who was once a master in his twenties of the <First Martial Arts>, but sold his clan and martial arts to Seongun and was given the position of 'Constellation'.」

Seeing that he is still living as a subcontractor for the 'Gourmet Association', his habits as a human do not change even if he became a Constellation.

[Maesonga, take it! This is the 'Hundred Steps Godly Fists!]

Of course, it wasn't [Hundred Steps Godly Fists]. The real Hundred Steps Godly Fists is not that shabby.

[This is a martial arts skill that brought even the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint to her knees!]

If Breaking the Sky Sword Saint were here, there'll be a sound that would make one's head fly off at once.

But there was no Breaking the Sky Sword Saint here, and it was only Jung Heewon and I who had to deal with him.

In the face of the explosion of power that took over the place in an instant, I frantically took a step back.

Fast.

No matter how constrained the opponent was by the scenario constraints, a Constellation was a Constellation, and at one time, he was a strong man who was listed as one of the 20 strongest members of <The First Murim>.

But it's worth a try.

A trajectory that Cheon Inho could not follow was visible.

[Exclusive skill 'Kendo Lv.10' is activated!]

Being visible means that there is an opportunity to counterattack as long as the body's abilities are supported.

Goooooooo!

Jung Heewon's [Kendo], which has already surpassed the level

of transcendence, is filled with the power of swords. A talent who self-taught her sword skills alone and would have undoubtedly competed for the place of the best in the world if she were in the <First Murim>.

The moment the lost guard Kwongak took his breath, Jung Heewon and I were already right in front of him.

[What—]

The sharp sword energy drew a brilliant trajectory to the guy's fist.

[Kaaaaaa—!]

What I can do is utilize all of Jung Heewon's potential while [Time of Judgment] lasts.

[Exclusive skill 'Demon Slayer Lv.10' is activated!]

Red natural flowers flickered at the corners of my eyes, and explosive power welled up.

I held 'Mikazuki Munechika' with both hands and swung it again and again.

From top to bottom and from left to right again.

"You—!"

The wrist of the unguarded Kwongak Taoist flew into the air.

I didn't miss the opportunity and attacked his arms.

[Some Constellations are astonished by the fighting power of incarnation 'Jung Heewon'!]

The sound of flesh being torn apart.

The panicked Taoist swordsman held onto Munechika Mikazuki's blade with one hand and unleashed a barrage of punches with the other hand.

[You dare!]

There was no place to escape unless I let go of the sword. A blow that would explode one's body with just one hit.

Still, I didn't let go of the sword. I believed in Jung Heewon’s history.

[Exclusive attribute 'Mad Butcher' activates!]

Her indomitable trait that made her enter the '100 Strongest People' of the Ways of Survival came into play.

Kudddddddd!

Jung Heewon’s body was not broken even by the pouring power. The aura surrounding her entire body burned even more fiercely.

The moment the 'Gwongak Taoist' screamed, Jung Heewon's sword moved once again. In addition, it is a sword strike imbued with the ability of [Time of Judgment].

「"I have to become stronger."」

On top of that, there is the time that Jung Heewon has accumulated so far.

「"I have to swing faster and stronger."」

I was able to find out what Jung Heewon was thinking of when practicing swordsmanship.

It was the most beautiful swordsmanship I had ever seen.

「"Only then can I protect Inho-ssi."」

Jung Heewon swung her sword again and again to catch up with him.

[Uh, how could it be that the only human in the scenario is—]

Each and every sword swung like that came together and finally came together at Jung Heewon's fingertips.

A level that an ordinary human being can never reach. A wall that even martial arts masters cannot overcome even after training for hundreds of years.

The wall was crumbling in the face of overwhelming talent.

「Transcendent type level 1.」

A sword made to break the sword of the King.

Her kendo blossomed into a brilliant beam of light, splitting the incarnation body of the 'Wingak Taoist' in half.

[High-ranking demon 'Wingak Taoist' has been killed!]

[The Constellation 'Wingak Taoist' receives a terrible shock and leaves the scenario!]

It was impossible.

Even though this is the twentieth scenario, it is a feat in which an incarnation with no sponsor defeats an incarnation possessed by a Historical-grade Constellation.

[The Constellations belonging to the Chinese Zodiac are greatly shocked by the power of the incarnation 'Jung Heewon'!]

[The Constellations of the Gourmet Association are making interested expressions!]

[A Constellation whose modifier has not yet been revealed is watching your battle.]

[5,000 coins were sponsored.]

[The battle of incarnation 'Jung Heewon' is leaked outside the 'Recycling Center' through the Management Bureau!]

There was no time to get drunk on the joy of victory. Jung Heewon’s body was rapidly becoming heavier.

[There is not enough probability to continue the 'Time of Judgment'.]

[After a while, the reaction of 'madness' will begin.]

Without stopping, I swung my sword at the 'filth addict' next to me.

There are two demons remaining. Before I couldn’t move her body at all, I had to kill all the remaining guys.

However, the 'filth addict', who foresaw his colleague's defeat, was already running away.

[Damn it! I’ve never heard of such a monster!]

Eventually, there was only one demon left.

[How pathetic. The title 'Gourmet Association' is a waste, Guru Kwon Gak.]

The Spear Master was glaring at me with cool eyes, as if he wasn't too shaken by my battle.

And the next moment, the spear master’s new form disappeared.

I swung my sword reflexively.

'Mikazuki Munechika' broke with a deep sibilant sound.

The powerful force emitted by the spear master destroyed Jung Heewon's sword and touched the blade of 'Mikazuki Munechika'.

A rapid spear attack followed.

Although it was frustrating, the 'spear master''s skills were real.

Unlike the Kwongak master who sold out his sect to Seongun and became a 'Constellation', this guy was truly a Constellation who achieved great feats with his own skills.

In an instant, blood spurted out from the damaged body.

['Time of Judgment' ends.]

To make matters worse, [Time of Judgment] has also ended.

Terrible pain radiated from every bone in my body. All I could really do now was stand.

The Spear Master was smiling as if he had already secured victory.

[It’s an amazing talent. If you had trained for ten more years, we could have had an interesting match.]

"If it had been one more minute, you would have passed out."

This is it.

By reducing the three high-level demons to one, the goal was achieved.

[I only kept my mouth shut because I thought you were going to die soon.]

The spear master's eyes scanned the entire body of Jung Heewon, whom I had possessed.

[It is a very desirable incarnation. If you want to live, I will give you a chance. If you become my 'incarnation'…]

The expression of the spear master who had been speaking so far hardened.

The reason was clear.

A roar heard from afar. Something was running towards us like a tank, plowing through the forest road.

A pitch-black coat blowing in the wind.

If Han Sooyoung were here, she would definitely have said this.

「"■Ba, as expected, the main character."」

I spoke to the high-ranking demon in a triumphant voice, like a fox riding on a tiger's back.

"It’s been a minute, kid."

The eyes of Yoo Joonghyuk, who came running out of breath, were looking in this direction.

It was clear what the guy saw to ran to us.

He must have read the phrase on the 'commercial signal flare' I fired earlier.

「Here is a demon king with your 'spear'.」

'Wolgeuk' is Yoo Joonghyuk’s decisive battle weapon for the 41st Round.

From my perspective, it was a stroke of luck that the 'Spear Master' obtained the Wolgeuk.

"Yoo Joonghyuk! Here we are!"

I shouted with all my might in Jung Heewon’s voice.

"Here is the villain of the world who stole your spear—"

The 'Spear Master' is a monster that should never be dealt with under normal circumstances, but with Yoo Joonghyuk in the '41st Round', it was an enemy worth fighting.

If the two of them calmly form a formation to stop them and kill them—

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

But Yoo Joonghyuk was looking somewhere else without even looking in my direction.

If he had seen that expression on his face, he would definitely have said this.

「"Isn’t that the look you make when you go to buy dumplings and there aren’t any left?"」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 774 Episode 34 Sibling (5)

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I turned my head to follow Yoo Joonghyuk’s gaze.

What was there was the Master of the Spear, and my incarnation body hanging out, bleeding profusely, with my stomach pierced by the spear.

I couldn't tell if Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at the Spear Master, Wolgeuk, or my incarnation body.

"You."

One thing is certain: Yoo Joonghyuk is very angry right now.

Anger at the fact that the demon dared to steal his equipment. Or anger at the guy who hurt me when I was still worth using.

I screamed reflexively as I saw Yoo Joonghyuk immediately lashing out.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

The level of aggression this guy gave was unusual.

['Restraint of Truth' is activated.]

[Some of the memories of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' are sealed.]

[All comprehensive abilities of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' temporarily exceed the scenario limit standards!]

[Explosive power surges from the whole body of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk'!]

You're activating [Story Engraving] right away like this?

The first story imprint, 'Restraint of Truth', is an imprint that seals part of the memory with its use itself.

What kind of memory did he lose again this time?

"Yoo Joonghyuk! Hey, you bastard!"

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't even look in this direction, probably because he didn't notice that I was possessing Jung Heewon's body.

A cotton spear was held in the man's hand, and profound magical power was concentrated in that spear.

The 'Spear Master', who instinctively felt threatened, burst out in anger.

[This guy!]

The magic that shot out like a beam of light left a dark mark in the air.

The 'Spear Master' staggered and parried Yoo Joonghyuk's blow. His expression changed, as if he was surprised by the heaviness of his magical power.

[I have been amazed many times today.]

The Spear Master also released his factory weapon and started stabbing.

The seedling that he had faithfully worked on for hundreds of years was poured out through Wolgeuk.

Kudddddddd!

Despite the storm of stabbings that surged in like waves, Yoo Joonghyuk did not even lift his eyebrows.

The [Eye of the Sage] shone in golden color.

The eyes of the guy who had already reached the peak destroyed the magical power composition of the pouring stab.

"Is this Jinjueonga’s style?"

The startled Spear Master narrowed his eyes and answered.

[Someone was exterminated. This is just my style.]

"Someone’s style resembles the movement of waves."

Yoo Joonghyuk rode the waves created by the demon's magic power. Some waves were broken and evaded, while others were avoided by twisting his body. He calmly moved forward step by step amidst the barrage of stabs with no way to avoid it.

"I once heard a story about a master from a certain family who sold his family’s martial arts skills."

The spear master did not respond and continued thrusting. A quick, heavy thrust. But none of them reached Yoo Joonghyuk.

In short, it was a technical limitation. The limit of technology that can be developed under the limited category of 'class'.

Nevertheless, his stab failed to hit Yoo Joonghyuk. It was proof that Yoo Joonghyuk's martial arts skill level was higher.

"Is this the only level you have reached after putting aside your family and skills?"

[I am the 'Spear Master!]

Finally, the Spear Master could not stand it anymore and growled.

[I practiced the spear longer than anyone else and received admiration as a reward for my efforts. This <Star Stream> recognized me. I am the 'King of Spears' of the <Star Stream>!]

"King of Spears? It looks like you haven’t met the 'Ancestor of Mankind' yet."

The progenitor of mankind. I also remembered that constellation.

Among the constellations that Yoo Joonghyuk fought, the constellation that used weapons the best.

"I’m sick of people calling themselves 'kings'."

There was deep darkness in the voice that came out.

"The Sword King, the Apprentice, the King of Fighters, the Emperor of Fist… they were guys who trained for hundreds of years on the time fault of the Dark Dimension. They were funny guys who threatened to cut off the heads of the Constellations someday."

Every time a Constellation title was mentioned, the 'Spear Master's' expression changed.

[W-what nonsense are you talking about? How did you get their names—]

"You are the worst of them all."

With a thudding sound, the Spear Master's new form was pushed away. He was crying and blood was pouring out. He had suffered great damage from the previous blow.

The spear master glared at Yoo Joonghyuk in disbelief.

[That can’t be possible. That can't be possible.]

As Yoo Joonghyuk took a step closer, the spear master also took a step back.

[I am the Master of Spears! Having practiced only one spear for hundreds of years—]

"Only a few hundred years."

The Spear Master’s shoulders shook as if he couldn't understand the indifferent voice.

[You… Who on earth are you?]

"A human who has been practicing for a little longer than hundreds of years."

[Bullshit-]

A rough, bouncing sibilant sound. The two changgeuks tied together swirled and emitted magical power.

The Spear Master did not know how long Yoo Joonghyuk had lived. He had no idea what time or what round he endured to get here.

Still, he felt it instinctively. The being in front of him is a monster. It is pitch-black darkness that cannot be illuminated by the light of the stars(?).

[The Constellation 'Spear Master' opens up the ranks!]

[The Bureau warns the 'Spear Master'.]

He was afraid of the unknown that the darkness held.

[The Constellation’s status as 'Spear Master' exceeds the scenario’s probability limit!]

[Some Constellations are starting to take interest in the battle.]

So the 'Spear Master' decided.

Even if it means breaking the rules of the scenario, he decided to kill the monster growing before his eyes with his own hands.

[I'm glad I met you now.]

The whole body of the 'Spear Master' who withstood the probability was hit by a storm.

[I will tear you to pieces and kill you before you grow any further.]

The two weapons collided and a loud noise erupted again.

I called out to Yoo Joonghyuk amidst the exploding dust.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

It cannot be done. If we fight here now, Yoo Joonghyuk will lose. Even if Yoo Joonghyuk was ahead in terms of skill and proficiency, the opponent was a 'Constellation' anyway.

Kudddddddd!

To put my worries to naught, Yoo Joonghyuk was fighting well.

Jinjueonga's style and Yoo Joonghyuk's Breaking the Sky intertwined, brightening the night sky.

It is truly a battle of the Baek Middle Ages.

Even though I thought about helping Yoo Joonghyuk, I couldn't take my eyes off the dazzling battlefield.

[The constellation 'Reclining Dragon' watches the battle.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' watches Yoo Joonghyuk's battle.]

[Some Constellations expect this battle to never end.]

The 'Spear Master' is a being of the highest rank among Historical-grade. Jung Heewon, who opened the first stage of Transcendents, was also a strong opponent who was no match for him.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk was equal in strength with the 'Spear Master', with only one story engraving activated.

「In that short period of time, Yoo Joonghyuk grew again.」

I realize once again that that person is Yoo Joonghyuk.

He is the protagonist of 『Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World』 and the embodiment of the strongest person on earth.

And this damned world was a place where a person with overwhelming talent could not see the true end even if he regressed thousands of times.

Crumble.

The balance of the battle was lost, and blood began to spurt from Yoo Joonghyuk's shoulders and thighs.

[Hahahahaha—What a pity!]

The Spear Master smiled happily.

Looking at Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardening, I quickly realized what the problem was.

His spear was swinging as if it would break at any moment.

I used all my remaining strength to lift up Jung Heewon's body. And then jumped into the battlefield.

A sharp crash of waves that surrounds the entire body.

[This is a distraction.]

The lightly surging waves blew away the body of Jung Heewon, who was rushing towards him.

Even though I was hit and bounced by the waves, I did not lose my sanity. Because starting now was important.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is released!]

While the Spear Master focused his attention on Jung Heewon, I woke up to my original body. A distant pain surged from my side where there was a hole, but I gritted my teeth and endured it.

I immediately took out the sword from my pocket and threw it at Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

The sword that flew rapidly along the [Way of the Wind] was held in Yoo Joonghyuk's right hand.

Although it was not a holy sword like the 'Raybringer', it was a weapon that could exert as much power as a holy sword, at least against demons.

'Unbreakable faith'.

Yoo Joonghyuk immediately infused magic into 'Unbreakable Faith'.

[Activates 'Blade of Faith'.]

[The special option of 'Unbreakable Faith' is activated.]

[Ether attribute is converted to 'Divinity'.]

Yoo Joonghyuk's ether blade, converted to divine properties, traced a trajectory.

The left arm of the 'Spear Master' flies like a hallucination.

The astonished 'Spear Master' testified.

[You, that sword is—]

Yoo Joonghyuk stormed out without giving him any time to rest. Yoo Joonghyuk's rebellious swordsmanship, which had great synergy with the 'Blade of Faith', turned the wave of the 'Spear Master' into tatters.

Originally, this would have been impossible due to the difference in status, but in this 'scenario', it was different.

The demons of this forest were designed to take enormous damage from 'holy attribute' items.

[Kaaaaaaat—]

Nevertheless, the Spear Master resisted until the end.

Red and white magic collided, creating a massive explosion.

While holding Jung Heewon in my arms, I reflexively rolled around on the floor.

The entire forest became incandescent and the aftereffects of the magic wave exploded.

A warm feeling passed through the back of my head.

After a while, I raised my head and looked at the epicenter of the explosion. Yoo Joonghyuk, now in tatters, was catching his breath with his sword stuck on the floor.

The incarnation body of the 'Spear Master' standing opposite was not visible. Only the 'Wolgeuk' stuck on the floor was trembling as if it recognized its true owner.

[The constellation 'Spear Master' suffered a terrible blow and left the scenario.]

Yoo Joonghyuk won.

[High-level demon 'Spear Master' has been defeated!]

[You have become a major contributor to the scenario!]

[You can obtain additional rewards when you finally clear the scenario.]

[The new story that is germinating is influenced by your achievements.]

Yoo Joonghyuk grabbed his Wolgeuk that had fallen on the floor and turned to me.

"You were alive?"

"Did you wish I were dead?"

I answered with a grin.

But to be honest, I felt like I was going to die soon. There was so much blood flowing from my pierced side. I blinked as if I was about to faint at any moment.

Yoo Joonghyuk stared at me with one of his eyes, as if he didn't like me, and took out a golden pill from his arms and threw it.

He then sat down next to me and shifted into his lotus position.

"To defeat the great demons, we need to save up our strength. Because of you, we wasted unnecessary strength."

I was dumbfounded by the one-sided notice, and then belatedly looked down at the pill that Yoo Joonghyuk had given me.

And after a while.

I was so startled that my eyes narrowed.

Oh my god, this is a 'Daehwandan'.

What is Daehwandan?

The greatest martial arts guru who can gain a double amount of magical power by eating just one pill, only gave up such a treasure for recovery purposes?

This bastard. Are you a good guy?

I shook my head at the foolish thought that suddenly occurred to me.

This guy isn't a bad guy, but he's not a good guy either.

It just means that Yoo Joonghyuk is also desperate for this scenario.

I split the Daehwandan and ate half, and fed the other half to Jung Heewon, who had collapsed.

Jung Heewon who was convulsing due to the side effects of [Madness] gradually began to stabilize when the effect of 'Daehwandan' took effect.

I managed to take a breather, but I couldn't say that the situation was good at all. Above all, the number of people unable to move increased by two.

—Writer!

A welcome message came just in time.

—Sorry. I tried to help right away, but I was also held back...

Ji Eunyu, who stuck her head out between the long bushes, was covered in dust all over. Judging by the thin cuts on her arms and legs, it appears that there were more demons remaining in the area.

I waved my hand, thinking it was okay.

Ji Eunyu opened her mouth first, as if she knew what I was going to say.

"Don’t say anything. Just stay."

"…"

"You saw what kind of people they were. There were three more high-level demons like that. No, there may have been more than that."

There are three high-level demons who chased after Goo Seonah and <Kim Dokja Company>. Even if there was only one monster like the 'Spear Master' involved, the situation would not be good.

"We can’t let them die."

"I know. But—"

Thanks to taking 'Daehwandan', the wound on my side healed quickly. There was no problem in moving my body right away.

"I know that Seonah-ssi is hostile towards me. Still, shouldn’t we talk? If there are any misunderstandings, we should resolve them."

"What if she’s not someone you can talk to? What if Goo Seonah is an unexpected villain?"

I looked at Ji Eunyu without answering. Ji Eunyu must have sensed my gaze and also closed her mouth.

Sometimes silence creates deeper understanding than a hundred words of explanation. This is especially true for Ji Eunyu and me.

Because we are people who created the same work.

She is the one who understands what I left behind better than anyone else. Even if I don't write it down, she will already know what I'm going to say.

And she probably knows better than anyone else that that sentence can never be modified.

Ji Eunyu lowered her head and spoke in a low voice.

"Ha... Is this how you feel, Yoo Sangah?"

"I'll be back soon, so please stay here. Please take care of the two of them."

"If anything happens, I will run away alone, so please come back quickly."

With a bitter smile, I glanced at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was having a good luck breakfast, and Jung Heewon, who had fainted, and immediately started running along the forest path.

There were traces of Goo Seonah and her group all over the grass, as well as the flags of the high-ranking demons who chased them.

A powerful energy was felt not far away. My heart was pounding. A somewhat familiar vibe.

I knew someone with a similar energy.

'The Demon King of Salvation'.

Although it was a little foreign, it definitely felt similar to my sponsor.

Maybe there is Kim Dokja around here?

When I finally made my way through the grass, I found the bodies of fallen high-level demons.

The corpses of demons were horribly torn apart.

When I slowly raised my head, I made eye contact with someone standing across the grass looking at me.

My brother, who looked exactly like me, was standing there.

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[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 775 Episode 35 Demon King Qualifications (1)

A chill passed over the nape of my neck.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' frowns.]

It started with 'Heir of the Eternal Name'.

[The story 'Recorder of Things that will Disappear' expresses sorrow.]

[The story 'One Who Rewrites Fate' gazes at fate.]

The stories I possessed were reacting to that being. It was warning me.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' expresses hatred.]

To eliminate that being in front of me.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' says that name is for only one person.]

If I leave that being alone, it will threaten me.

But I shook my head.

"If you can't control stories, you will live according to the stories' will."

More than anything, I knew who that 'Kim Dokja' was.

"Goo Seonah-ssi." The moment I called her name, a loud thunder rumbled in the sky.

Was someone else in the distance overdoing the probability?

A pitch-black darkness was flowing out from the sky that was cracked as if it would break at any moment.

[The probability constraints of the scenario weaken.]

In any case, it made it easier for me.

[The worldview turns its eyes to the probability collision area.]

As the worldview constraints weakened, the restrictions on speech loosened. Now, I could have a free conversation with Goo Seonah.

"Goo Seonah-ssi. Let's stop now."

Goo Seonah. I recalled the information I knew about her. There might be some clue left inside me that could convince her.

Her ID is strawberry1137.

Reader level 46.

Reading count 8 times.

Judging from her ID, she's probably someone who likes strawberries. 1137 might be some kind of anniversary.

For example, March 7th of the 11th year. I shook my head. This wasn't enough. I needed more information about her.

[Use 'Reader Comment List' on the person.]

* You can check the comments written by the reader using coins.

* Currently, there are 3 comments that can be checked for free.

A skill that I didn't use often because I felt uncomfortable looking at other people's comments. But now, there was no other way.

When I activated the skill, the comments she had left came to mind one by one.

> No, does this make sense? No matter what, it makes sense to split the reader in half? This is really the author's fault.
>
> —(Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, Chapter 516)

He's back, right? He's back, right? He's back? She smiled brightly! Sooyoung can't be so bright if it's not the case! —(Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint, Chapter 551)

> I recently told my friend about this novel.. He said it was fun.. Happy...
>
> —(Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint, Chapter 551)

Somehow it didn’t feel real.

I thought of Goo Seonah I saw in Chungmuro. Her expression was somehow poisonous and her eyes were strong. She didn’t trust people easily.

The Goo Seonah in the Internet comment window was different from the Goo Seonah I knew. Her comments were lively, her joy and sadness were clear, and I couldn’t sense even a shadow.

I read and reread the last comment she wrote. Then, a conversation suddenly came to mind.

To be exact, it wasn’t my memory, but the memory of the acting person 'Kim Kyungsik' that I had absorbed.

In my memory, the two of them were sitting on the platform in Chungmuro and chatting away.

The memory was damaged, so I couldn’t hear most of the conversation well, but I could hear a few words from Goo Seonah clearly.

「"There's someone I need to find."」

Goo Seonah's expression as she said those words was also vivid.

「"If I possessed someone in this world, that guy would definitely be here too."」

Maybe this is why I can't ignore her.

Her life is not here. So I have a duty to send her back to her own world. I've always thought that way.

"Goo Seonah, what on earth have you done?"

Goo Seonah, whose eyes met mine, had a face that was even more like 'Kim Dokja' than 'Jungchul'.

She tilted her head with a subtle smile.

Her gaze fell on the floor. There were the mortal bodies of the incarnations that were limp.

I've never talked to them directly, but they were all faces I knew.

Students from Class A.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' cries out in pain while feeling nauseous!]

They were students who were the terminal incarnations of <Twelve Zodiac Signs>.

[The Constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' breaks the brick house in agony!]

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' bites his nails and goes into a seizure!]

The screams of the Constellations echoed in my ears.

[The Constellation 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' goes into a frenzy.]

[The Constellation 'Pig in a Brick House' goes into a frenzy.]

[The Constellation 'Nail-Eating Rat' goes into a frenzy.]

Goo Seonah, who has become even more like 'Kim Dokja' than before.

The incarnations that are dropping as if they are dead.

The Constellations are in pain.

"I just made it easier for you."

Goo Seonah was saying.

"You know that too. These guys, they barely have any 'reader' egos left. So I'm going to cut out that part and put it in a bag."

"Then the readers—"

She smiled brightly and pointed at herself with her thumb. The intense and ominous feeling felt from her whole body,

[The story 'The Master of the Heart-Bearer' is out!]

She had absorbed the 'Kim Dokja fragments' that the Constellations of <Twelve Zodiac Signs> had.

"Why are you looking at me like that? They're the ones who harassed us. You must have had a hard time because of them too."

That's right. I had a hard time because of them too.

In particular, when I met the 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes' in the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> scenario, I almost died.

But they weren't hostile to me from the beginning.

The 'Tiger Eating Rice Cakes', the 'Pig in a Brick House', and the 'Nail-eating Rat' were the same.

At Geumho Station, at Chungmuro Station, and even during 'The Sponsor Selection(?).'

They were the Constellations who cheered me on the most. Maybe that's why I was always reluctant to confront them sincerely.

Even if they had almost no 'Reader' soul left, even if only 1 percent of the soul fragments remained, it was okay. For that 1 percent, I could have thrown myself at them over and over again to save them.

But.

"I just did what you did. We're the same."

I unconsciously took a step back as I watched Goo Seonah calmly spread her arms.

"So let's just be one, Kim Dokja."

Until now, I believed that there was a minimum level of good. I wanted to believe that she would at least not touch the same 'reader'.

But she crossed that line as if it were a joke.

"You're really good at talking like Nirvana."

It was only one step.

In that one step, Goo Seonah's white hand, which had come close to my nose, reached out toward my neck.

I reflexively swung my 'Unbreakable Faith' and swatted her hand away. Even though it hit her hand, there was a sharp, metallic sound.

Her entire hand was shining like a fresh fingernail.

I looked into the story.

The story of the 'Nail-Eating Rat'— 「The Cornered Fingernail」. A story that strengthens a part of the body to a level close to a sacred relic.

I swung my sword once more. Her nails and the sword clashed several times, and the magical power that came into contact was canceled out and turned into a loud noise. Judging from the level of recoil, the amount of magical power and physical strength that each of us had were similar.

Goo Seonah smiled brightly.

"I will kill the 'Daemajok'. You just get out of here."

"Why on earth are you doing this?"

"I didn't start this. You started this."

"You haven't even heard my story yet! You didn't even ask what happened between me and Kim Kyungsik-ssi, or what you saw!"

Goo Seonah's nails that had been clashing fiercely stopped for the first time.

"Kim Kyung-sik."

I nodded.

Finally, my chance to speak had come.

What she saw that day was a misunderstanding, and while it's true that I absorbed Kim Kyungsik-ssi's soul, I never killed him. That's what I tried to explain.

"I forgot. Did you think I was doing this because of that old man?"

It wasn't because of Kim Kyungsik?

Then why on earth does Goo Seonah have such strong hostility toward me?

The crackling sound erupted once again, and we simultaneously took three or four steps back.

Goo Seonah stared at me with clear eyes. Then she frowned as if she was displeased.

"You really don't know?"

"What do you mean?"

"You made everything happen with this and forgot about it yourself?"

Goo Seonah let out a strange laugh and raised her hand. Soon, she snapped her fingers.

My heart felt cold.

The soul she had absorbed, 'Christina Page's' special skill, had been activated.

[Character 'Goo Seonah' activates 'Daily Corpse Lv. 10'!]

[Daily Corpse is a skill that causes the soul to separate from the body as soon as it is activated. But I have a countermeasure.]

「I am 'Kim Dokja' who cannot be hypnotized.」

But the moment I activated [Incite], I realized something was strange.

I was not the one on whom she activated [Daily Corpse].

"I'll make you remember."

[Character 'Goo Seonah' activates 'Hypnosis Incite Lv. 10'.]

At the same time, incarnations came out from all over the bushes, trembling.

They were all familiar faces.

Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, Kim Namwoon, and even Shin Yoosung.

Perhaps due to the influence of [Daily Corpse], the four people's eyes were empty.

Lee Hyunsung moved at the same time as Goo Seonah's nod.

[Character Lee Hyunsung activates 'Mountain Breaker Lv. 9'!]

Lee Hyunsung's huge fist slammed into the ground. The dirt floor flipped over as if there was an earthquake, and a ringing sound was heard. While my senses were disturbed, Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon rushed forward, piercing through the dust.

Kaga River!

I held 'Unbreakable Faith' and 'Sain Chamsagum' in pairs and struck back at the two's attacks. My palms were tingling from the heavy blows.

Next came Shin Yoosung. The 8th-grade sea creatures controlled by the child began to play together.

['Naggak Ensemble' is starting!]

However, the Naggak Ensemble was not toward me, but was rising in a completely different direction, creating dissonance.

Goo Seonah frowned and said.

"Shin Yoosung, do it right."

As I watched Shin Yoosung's trembling shoulders, a strange dissonance arose in my heart as well.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' laughs brightly.]

I wanted to save up some strength for the final battle. But now I had to admit it.

Goo Seonah is strong. If she can control such strong characters at will, she might be considered superior to the 'higher-level demons'.

She has collected that many 'Kim Dokja fragments'.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' begins its storytelling as if it had been waiting for it.]

If it had been before, it would have been a power that I would have used after watching the situation. But now that the world's gaze is focused elsewhere, it would be okay.

[One of the 'Demon King of Salvation's' stories awakens due to the effect of 'Heir of the Eternal Name'.]

[The story 'Bug Slaughter' can now be used temporarily.]

Story, 『'Bug Slaughter』.

It was the story that the 'Demon King of Salvation' obtained after defeating the demon count 'Tentachio' in the Dark Castle.

「A tale of overwhelming power when the opponent is 'weaker than you'.」

Of course, Lee Hyunsung was too strong to apply this 'tale'. Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye, and maybe even Shin Yoosung were incarnations who could easily overwhelm me with their immediate performances.

But there was something they could never surpass me.

「That's the 'strength' of the real story.」

Hmm, I took a deep breath and immediately put a stop to the strength that I had been holding back.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation (Agent)' reveals his strength!]

The movements of Lee Hyunsung and his party stopped in their tracks at the sudden release of strength.

I didn't miss that moment and activated my skill.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated!]

In fact, I didn't want to use this skill on people I knew. But now, there was no other way.

I placed my hand on Lee Hyunsung's shoulder as he rushed toward me.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite' is in sync with 'Insect Massacre'.]

Suddenly, that thought occurred to me.

Maybe dreaming isn't just about the 'oldest dream'.

「This world is a huge [Incite]. All beings are just moving from one dream to another.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, Cheon Inho, Asmodeus, Goo Seonah, and Ye Hyunwoo. They all have their own dreams. They also fight to bring the characters to their own dreams.

Perhaps, I am the same.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite' exerts an overwhelming influence on incarnations of lower rank than you!]

However, as always, there is something you must do first to dream a new dream.

"Hyunsung-ssi."

Wake up from the 'old dream'.

"Do you remember the trumpet sound?"

Lee Hyunsung's shoulders began to shake like crazy.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 776 Episode 35 Demon King Qualifications (2)

"This, this, Private Lee Hyunsu—!"

Lee Hyunsung, foaming at the mouth, had a seizure and collapsed.

Goo Seonah's eyes, watching from afar, widened.

"How—"

I poked Lee Hyunsung's shoulder as he collapsed. Lee Hyunsung, who had completely lost consciousness, only repeated faint convulsions.

As I watched him drooling, I thought that this operation would not work. Even if breaking Goo Seonah's hypnosis was the most urgent task, the characters also had human rights.

I quickly passed Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye, and Shin Yoosung and said.

"From now on."

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated!]

"You all will wake up from hypnosis."

The characters that touched my fingertips convulsed like Lee Hyunsung. But they didn’t foam at the mouth or scream in trauma like that.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' conflicts with 'Daily Instigation Lv. 10'!]

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' conflicts with 'Hypnosis Incite Lv. 10'!]

A spark of probability flew from the air, and soon the characters collapsed on the spot like puppets with their strings cut.

Goo Seonah, who only then realized what I had done, approached me and said.

"[Incite], I guess you can use it like this."

"Let’s stop now. I can subdue you in the same way."

"Me? It won’t work on me? Because [Incite]—"

Goo Seonah, who had closed the distance in an instant once again, reached out to me.

"It’s only effective against opponents with a lower 'rank' than you, right?"

「The nail in the corner aimed for my neck. I quickly tilted my upper body back to dodge the attack and activated [Incite] at the same time.」

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' is activated!]

"You are now—"

The skill was nullified with a sound of 'Tsutsut'.

[The activation of 'Incite' was canceled.]

Goo Seonah was laughing.

"I told you it wasn't possible?"

In fact, it wasn't impossible. If her rank wasn't that far behind, it was theoretically possible to resist [Incite] using 「Insect Massacre」.

But even if she had collected a lot of 'Kim Dokja Fragments', would she have a rank that wouldn't be pushed back by me, the agent of the 'Demon King of Salvation'?

I held 'Unbreakable Faith' tightly with both hands and released my magical power.

['Blade of Faith' is activated!]

This was a quick and easy decision.

I had consumed 'DaeHwan-Dan' and had sufficient magical power. It would be best to subdue Goo Seonah as quickly as possible and go deal with the Demon Tribe.

However, Goo Seonah was not about to be easily defeated.

"Kim Dokja insisted on that weapon until the very end. I really didn't like that."

The pure white 'Ravelinger' glowed in Goo Seonah's hand.

"Why did he insist on that one when there were so many items?"

The 'Blade of Faith' and 'Ravelinger' clashed, bathing the place in bright light.

'Ravelinger' is a weapon that exerts power beyond that of a holy relic in this world.

[Character 'Goo Seonah' activates the skill 'Moonlight Sword Technique Lv. 10'!]

Moonlight Sword Technique.

The sword technique that Bihyung first recommended, and one that Kim Dokja did not purchase.

Goo Seonah chose that sword technique and learned it. As if to prove that Kim Dokja was wrong.

"The path that Kim Dokja took is not the only right one."

「Moonlight Sword Technique, whose proficiency was at its peak, stabbed my shoulder and thigh. I barely activated Baekcheongganggi to block the attack, and then I saw the iron club held in Goo Seonah's left hand.」

Her main weapon that made her known as the 'Iron Club Lady'.

[Character 'Goo Seonah' activates the skill 'Cheonryeongchu Lv.10'!]

The iron club flying in from a certain direction narrowed my range of movement, and there was no room to dodge [Moonlight Sword Technique].

As if it had been waiting, the Ravelinger emitted light.

A vein burst from my chest and pain consumed my mind.

"Your physique is terrible. Your combat proficiency is also low. How on earth have you survived until now?"

Goo Seonah continued to push me as if mocking me.

"Are you by any chance a one-trick pony like Kim Dokja?"

I realized something new.

We all read the same story of the world, but the way we understand it is different. There is no guarantee that someone who reads the same book repeatedly will necessarily 'read' better.

Perhaps someone who reads it once can understand the story better than someone who reads it a hundred times.

And this was Goo Seonah's reading.

The reading that only 'Goo Seonah' experienced, and that I and other readers did not experience.

She survived in this world with that experience. Learning the Wolyeonggeom method with one hand and Cheonchu with the other.

At the point where she was competing on equal footing with me, the agent of the 'Demon King of Salvation', her reading was already proven.

She barely achieved the same level as my story after fighting with 'gods of the other world' and fighting a life-or-death battle. Of course, the way she formed her 'level' was somewhat different from mine.

「She supplemented the insufficient quality of the story with the quantity of the stories, and strengthened the cohesion of the story with 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.」

The small stories embedded in her entire body were talking to me as if they were screaming.

[The story 'The Exciting Nail' wants to imitate you!]

[The story 'Rice Cake, More Rice Cake than Meat' looks at you.]

[The story 'A Brick House That's Good for Hiding' shows interest in you.]

The Tiger Eating Rice Cakes. The Rat Eating Nails. The Dog Throwing Itself into a Flame. Pig in a Brick House...

The stories of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> constellations were inhabiting her body and forming a single constellation.

[The story 'Master of the Twelve Zodiac Signs' shines brightly.]

That was the story she had.

The story, 「Master of the Twelve Zodiac Signs」.

A story that ties together the stories of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> that were scattered everywhere.

「The Wisdom of Animals to Fight Against the Tale of the Great with the Power of Great People.」

Thus, the leader of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs>, who had never been born in the main story of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'—was momentarily revealed before my eyes.

"I won't lose."

The moment I heard those words, I felt a sense of realization. How long had she planned this stage?

"I will never do that to you. Even without items! Even without colleagues!"

Goo Seonah, gritting her teeth and swinging her blade and iron club, was fierce. The history she lived left fatal scars all over my body.

「Wow, this chapter was really fun!」

One, and then another, as each and every slash increased, I thought of the comments she left.

「But does he like Yoo Sangah or Han Sooyoung?」

She was the reader who liked Kim Dokja more than anyone else—Kim Dokja's choice.

「Wow, I would never have done that if it were me. As expected of Kim Dokja!!」

I didn't know what made her so sad. That's why I wanted to understand her anger.

I was curious about her purpose and motivation.

Even at this moment, when I was enduring such intense attacks.

「I was thinking that I even wanted to write this story.」

"Aaaaaaaah—!"

Goo Seonah's kick, seizing the opportunity, struck my abdomen. The moment my breath caught in my throat, the iron club aimed at my heart moved.

「How much effort did Goo Seonah have to put in to become this strong?」

All of her actions turned into sentences in my head. I even thought that it wouldn't be bad to die here.

Strangely, what came to mind at that moment was the face of Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st round.

「"As long as you don't give up on life, I will continue to use you."」

I still haven't kept my promise from back then. I promised not to make this story a tragedy, so I can't die yet.

I can't die.

[The 'Blade of Faith' burns brightly!]

I concentrated my saved magic power and struck the iron club with the blade. I put strength into my heel and took a stance, then felt the wind blowing.

[Way of the Wind.]

Goo Seonah's body staggered in the fierce wind that swept in.

"You—"

The stories of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> howled loudly throughout Goo Seonah's body.

「The Rat's Dexterity」

「The Tiger's Strength」

「The Rabbit's Leaping Power」

「The Snake's Recovery Power」

...

When the fragments of the stories of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> simultaneously raised their voices, my head felt dizzy. However, I also had a 'story fragment' for moments like this.

[Story fragment, 'Understanding of the Unemployed' begins its storytelling.]

Story fragments obtained in exchange for clearing Zone 13.

There, I helped animals that had lost their homes, had lost their way, or had lost their stories.

「Understanding of the Unemployed.」

And in return for that help, I barely managed to obtain a line of understanding.

[Story fragment 'The Tiger's Strength' senses your gaze.]

Goo Seonah's muscular strength, which had been running towards me, rapidly weakened.

[Story fragment 'Understanding of the Overthroned' senses your gaze.]

Her feet, which had been positioned at the right place at the right time, slowed down.

[Story fragment 'Rabbit's Leaping Power' satisfies your understanding.]

Her movements as she jumped back became dull.

I didn't miss that gap and struck her hand holding the iron club hard.

The iron club rolled on the floor in vain.

[Story fragment 'Master of the Twelve Zodiac Signs' fumbles with its storytelling.]

The effect of the story fragment 「Understanding of the Overthroned」 is very simple.

Becoming the 'only understander' of the beasts.

As long as I have this story fragment, the constellations of the animal kingdom cannot truly be hostile to the being with this story fragment.

[Story fragment 'Tiger's Strength' stops its storytelling.]

[Story fragment 'Rat's Footwork' stops its storytelling.]

[Story fragment 'Rabbit's Leaping Power' stops its storytelling.]

…

[Story fragment 'Master of the Twelve Zodiac Signs' stops talking.]

The moment Goo Seonah, who was watching the futile collapse of story fragments, suddenly came to her senses, I grabbed her shoulder without missing a moment.

"It's the end, Goo Seonah-ssi."

Goo Seonah's knees buckled as she heard the voice filled with [incite]. Nevertheless, she resisted until the end.

Her lips were tightly clenched. Tears of blood flowed from her eyes glaring at me.

"This is unreasonable."

That's right. This fight is unfair.

This is because our 'reading' and the text given to us were not fair in the first place.

"I know it would end up like this anyway, that expression is annoying."

I had nothing to say in protest about this unfair fight. I just hoped she would give up.

After struggling for a long time, Goo Seonah finally lowered her head.

"Stop wasting time and kill me."

"I won't kill you."

"You're going to kill me anyway, just like you did to Kyungsik."

"I didn't kill Kyungsik-ssi."

"Don't lie. You—"

[Character 'Goo Seonah' activates 'Lie Detection Lv. 8'!]

[Character 'Goo Seonah' confirms that what you said is true.]

Goo Seonah looked up at me blankly.

"Really... You didn't kill him?"

"How many times have I said I didn't kill him?"

"Why? You're Kim Dokja. Didn't you want to be the only Kim Dokja?"

It's true that my story keeps talking about such things.

However, just because my story says so, it doesn't mean I have to act accordingly.

"I just don't want this world to end in tragedy."

But Goo Seonah seemed to find my answer funny.

"Do you think you have the right to say such things?"

"Huh?"

"You... Do you really not know how this 'world' came into being?"

"How could I know that?"

"I see. You still don't have a fragment of 'that memory'…"

Goo Seonah muttered, looking up at the distant sky.

"I don't know if you haven't gotten it, or if someone is preventing you from regaining that memory…"

"Do you know how this world came into being, Seonah-ssi?"

"Are you curious?"

Goo Seonah began to laugh as if she had just thought of something. As if what was about to happen would be some kind of refreshing revenge against me.

"Absorb me. Then you will know the answer you were looking for."

I frowned.

"Why? You don't like it?"

"Seonah-ssi."

"Aren't you curious? Why did your sponsor, which you were looking for so desperately, end up like that? Why did 'Kim Dokja' have to be torn apart into several pieces?"

A cool breeze blew down my spine.

Goo Seonah was smiling brightly as if she already knew what choice I would make.

"Why didn't the 'Kim Dokja' we knew return to <Kim Dokja Company>? Aren't you really curious?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 777 Episode 35 Demon King Qualifications (3)

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I had been asked a similar question a while ago.

【Do you really want to know? Even if the truth could ruin you forever?】

The owner of the voice said. You will be able to know the truth when you reach the final chapter of the 'Recycling Center'.

I wondered if that was what it meant.

「Why didn't Kim Dokja return to <Kim Dokja Company>?」

I was curious. Of course I couldn't help but be curious.

"Seonah-ssi, I won't absorb you."

"…"

"No matter how curious I am, I don't want to know the answer that way."

Goo Seonah wasn't someone I could call my colleague. There was a wall as thick as a piece of paper between her and me.

However, I understood her at least in the sentences written on that piece of paper.

Now I know who she was looking for in this world. I also know what kind of person she liked and what kind of sentences she loved. That's why I can't absorb her. Because I want her to exist as a reader who reads this story beyond the paper.

"I don't like that."

Goo Seonah said, glaring at my hand that was holding her shoulder.

"You don't do this. You don't do that. Do you still think this world is just a 'novel'?"

"..."

"Do you think I absorbed other readers because I like it?"

Goo Seonah's eyes sparkled.

No reader wants to absorb the souls of other readers. Goo Seonah must have felt the same way.

"You know. Those who have already been branded as 'Kim Dokja fragments' are all being tracked by the Constellations."

Goo Seonah said, looking up at the sky.

Beyond that sky where lightning strikes, there were definitely nebulae waiting for us.

Those who are trying to control the dreams of this world by collecting 'Kim Dokja fragments'.

"The Recycling Center is protecting us now, but how long do you think that will be possible? They will soon start tracking us."

"..."

"This scenario is our last chance. Our last chance to protect ourselves. Here, as many 'Kim Dokja fragments' as possible must become one. We must become strong enough to stand against those Constellations in the sky."

Goo Seonah's mumbling words almost sounded like a spell.

"We must become a single 'Kim Dokja."

Maybe I knew that too.

But I spoke as if I was rebelling against that fact.

"That's not the only way. Why don't we join forces? Even if we don't become one, we can become a team."

"That's not enough. We're just ordinary people, except for the fact that we have Kim Dokja fragments."

"<Kim Dokja Company> were also ordinary people at first."

"So we can do it too? Do you know what kind of novel this is?"

"It might become a novel someday."

Goo Seonah started laughing like crazy. Then, she suddenly stopped laughing and looked at me.

"As expected, you are 'Kim Dokja'."

The moment I turned around with an eerie feeling, her left hand, which had changed into something like a vice, grabbed my wrist.

Story fragment, 「Memory-biting Snake」.

I thought it was a second chance.

Could it be that this conversation was just a way to buy time to prepare for this?

I quickly activated 「Understanding of the Overthroned」.

[Memory-Biting Snake has no intention of harming you.]

The ability of 「Memory-biting Snake」 is to inject some of its own memories into others.

My vision slowly turned white.

Goo Seonah was faintly smiling in the midst of that.

"I'll make sure you remember clearly. What did you, 'Kim Dokja', do?"

A sentence slowly came to mind in the brightly colored sight.

「This is a story for that one reader.」

That memory starts from the last sentence of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 written by Han Sooyoung.

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「I hope many people read this story.」

That was Kim Dokja's first wish.

So he left recommendations on the Internet and left comments. He went around recommending the same story to people.

He got cursed at.

At the time, he didn't understand. Why didn't they read all the interesting stories if they just endured a little?

Now he knows why.

The story that saved him wasn't salvation for others.

Accepting that simple fact was very difficult for Kim Dokja as a child.

「And that story caught the eye of one person.」

When he looked around, the first thing he saw was the bed in the hospital room. As his heart slowly beat repeatedlyt, the plan began to move throughout his body.

Those delicious things came to mind as an example. From the first scenario to the last.

Separating from the group on the subway, becoming a 'long-standing dream', and finally the moment when his soul disintegrated and scattered across the universe, all of it.

"Ha—"

The voice flowing out didn't feel real. He didn't think he would be able to come back.

Still, he came back. He definitely came back.

「This is not a dream.」

Tears welled up with his overflowing emotions and his heart pounded hard.

「Han Sooyoung succeeded.」

He heard someone running outside the hospital room.

A familiar sound and a familiar voice. He wanted to kick the bed and hug them right away. He wanted to tell them that he missed them. But.

[Your current existence restoration is 41%.]

The system message that appeared before his eyes stopped his actions.

「His existence wasn't completely restored, was it?」

He recalled the events that had happened while reading 'Memories of the World.' One, his soul was completed as 'the Oldest Dream' and scattered throughout the universe.

Second. Han Sooyoung wrote a novel to be read by his soul fragments who were reincarnated throughout the universe.

Three, his reincarnated soul fragments read Han Sooyoung's novel and 'Kim Dokja' came to embrace them.

Four, the embrace of 'the oldest dream' became reality.

If that assumption was good, he should have been completely restored and become one Kim Dokja.

But now his soul's restoration is not 100%, not 51%, not 49%, but 41%.

Kim Dokja became anxious as he heard the footsteps of the approaching party.

「Am I what the party wants me to be now?」

「Do I have all my memories of them?」

That fear raised Kim Dokja's body. Although he could not use his full power as 'the oldest dream', he could search the entire world line and regain the remaining memories as he was now.

「Kim Dokja thought.」

Yes, let's recover the remaining lost memories before meeting the group.

「It'll only take a moment.」

It wasn't difficult to find the fragments of memory.

Once he started 'worldline exploration', the pieces that contained his memories were captured heading to 'a certain worldline' all at once.

He followed the flow and floated through the universe.

And finally, he reached the place where the memories were gathered.

The moment he witnessed the shape of the universe, Kim Dokja's heart raced again. It was because he knew where that place was.

「The forgotten 41st Round.」

Kim Dokja was genuinely surprised.

That was a world that even he, the 'Oldest Dream', didn't know about. In a sense, it was a world where existence itself could not be established.

A dream that the 'oldest dream' couldn't have. Because such a world could not exist. Even so, that world existed right before his eyes.

Even,

[Is this the 'Oldest Dream'?]

Someone showed intense hostility to him.

[I can't believe it, I really thought it would come...]

A thousand bees blocked his path.

Stars with dazzling lights that seemed like they could light up an entire galaxy.

Kim Dokja slowly looked around the vast army of stars and recognized the Constellations at the forefront. Kim Dokja knew who those stars were.

[Odin.]

Odin of <Asgard>.

[Zeus. Poseidon.]

Zeus and Poseidon of <Olympus>.

[Mithra.]

Even the Mythical Constellation Mithra of <Vedas>.

The masters of the most famous Nebulae in the <Star Stream> were there.

Normally, the Constellations would have been furious just by hearing their true names. However, no Mythical Constellation dared to object to Kim Dokja's words. The opponent was a 'god' who dreamed of this universe.

The concepts of a fairy tale or a myth had no meaning in front of the 'Oldest Dream'.

[I don't know why you blocked my path, but I'll say it once. Get out of the way.]

The Constellations of the nebulae trembled at the same time at Kim Dokja's words.

Even so, none of the stars moved. Rather, they seemed determined to protect their positions even if it meant burning all of their stories.

[That can't happen.]

It was questionable.

Even if it was a Myth-grade Constellation, there was no way it could refuse his orders. Was that a tribute to the star that had read the most stories in this world?

[Really? Then there's nothing I can do.]

In the end, the moment Kim Dokja raised his hand to clear the Constellations, a light spark flew from his fingertips.

Look at this?

Probability is the will of the Constellations that make up the <Star Stream>.

In other words, it meant that a strong flow that could cause an aftershock to him was restricting his actions.

[There must be a pretty great being behind you.]

Kim Dokja's eyes were filled with interest. A dazzling light swirled around in his hand, and a broken sword appeared.

'Unbreakable Faith'.

The mythical blade that accompanied his story finally revealed itself in the universe.

[If you want to stop it, stop it.]

Nothing can change his determination.

<Kim Dokja Company> revived him. Therefore, he had a duty to return to them as a complete Kim Dokja. For them, Kim Dokja would do anything.

[Stop it!]

As Odin's chant and his sacred relic 'Gungnir' shot down like a meteor, Zeus, Astraphe and Kronos fell down after being struck by lightning.

The screams of the Constellations caught in the storm of stories spread out fiercely.

A joint attack by the highest gods of <Asgard> and <Olympus>. Kim Dokja took on the omnipotent attack that was enough to erase an entire world with just one sword.

Light exploded with a roar, and the longing for a cataclysmic upheaval that shook the entire topography of the universe continued.

In that scenery, Kim Dokja, covered in pitch-black star dust, smiled brightly.

[Kill him! He is just a Constellation!]

The Constellations did not give up and rushed forward. They were determined to block his path no matter what.

When Kim Dokja cut down one Constellation, two rushed forward, and when he cut down three, four rushed forward.

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is moving.]

It was impossible to destroy all the Constellations like this.

In the end, Kim Dokja frowned.

Even though he was the 'Oldest Dream', its power was now vaguely restored. If he used his power incorrectly here, he could get caught up in a probability aftermath and the entire nearby world line could evaporate.

It was best to quickly enter the '41st Round' while responding to the Constellations' power to an appropriate level.

Kim Dokja, who had made up his mind, activated [Way of the Wind].

[Let's go.]

They felt a wind blowing from somewhere, and with a momentary gesture, the canal of Constellations shook. Kim Dokja took advantage of the gap and moved. Faster than lightning or a meteor.

Kim Dokja, who had become a single gust of wind, managed to break through the nebula's net.

[Stop him!]

The weapons that had surged past Kim Dokja's body. Even with the snow flying instead of blood, Kim Dokja did not rest. He just had to go a little further. Just a little further—

「A story he doesn’t know is waiting.」

That’s how he finally touched the 'Void Curtain' of the world line.

[Up to there.]

Someone grabbed his wrist.

Kim Dokja looked down at the hand that was holding him and asked.

[It’s you. The one who moved the Constellations.]

Then the owner of the hand answered.

[Yes. It’s me.]

Kim Dokja slowly looked back at the being.

A being in this universe who dared touch his body and was safe. When he thought about it, there was only one such being.

[You came to find me, right?]

He was the clone he left behind in this world.

[Yes, I came to find you.]

49% of Kim Dokja.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 778 Episode 35 Demon King Qualifications (4)

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[You came to find me.]

Kim Dokja stared blankly at his clone and tilted his head.

[But no matter how much I think about it, it doesn't make sense.]

[What?]

[How can you exist here?]

Even if the time of the <Star Stream> moved toward the 'empty space' of the story, this was a nonsensical story.

Whether it was 51% or 49%, all of Kim Dokja's soul fragments were disintegrated and scattered into space.

It became the <Star Stream> itself.

If it weren't for the novel written by Han Sooyoung, Kim Dokja wouldn't have survived now.

But how could 49% of his clone exist in such a distant place?

What's even stranger is that the clone in front of him feels like it existed much longer than that.

The clone answered.

[If you exist, it wouldn’t be so strange if I exist.]

[Han Sooyoung didn’t write stories like that.]

The look in the clone’s eyes changed subtly.

[Of course.]

[You are me. I am you. If Han Sooyoung’s story had been successful, we should have been restored as one person.]

[It’s simple. We are no longer 'one'.]

We are not one.

Kim Dokja thought about those words for a moment and then said.

[Let’s go back. There are people waiting for us.]

[They must be people waiting for you.]

[What nonsense are you talking about?]

[Remove your hand and leave.]

[What?]

[The world you are trying to intervene in now is 'my world'.]

Only then did Kim Dokja look at the 'Void Curtain' that he had placed his hand on. The world inside this 'Void Curtain' was a world that even Kim Dokja, who had been the oldest dream, did not know about.

「How could a world he did not know exist?」

The realization came a little too late. The answer to the question was simple.

Because his clone in front of him had become this world’s 'oldest dream'.

He had watched over this world so that it could come to life and its characters could live.

[I see. You… don’t want this world to end, do you?]

The clone didn’t answer.

Kim Dokja let out a light sigh and added.

[You can imagine this place even when you go back. So let’s go back. I’ll read this story with you. You don’t have to carry it alone—]

Since when did it start? The clone that had the same 'Unbreakable Faith' as his had been aiming at his neck.

[What are you doing?]

He was confused.

Why did the clone harbor such strong hostility toward him?

[I just said it. This is my 'world'. I don’t want to read it with you.]

[Where is your world, my world? You…]

He has used [Avatar] many times before, but this has never happened before.

A clone that has escaped the control of the main body.

It was like him yesterday, or him the day before yesterday, suddenly declaring, 'I am Kim Dokja'.

[You really.]

Kim Dokja thought of Han Sooyoung’s avatar that he had met in the 1,863rd Round a long time ago.

That Han Sooyoung had also escaped the control of the main body and had her own ego.

What if the clone in front of him had become that kind of case?

Kim Dokja smiled and asked.

[Who are you?]

[What?]

[Who gathered you?]

The clone’s pupils wavered for a moment.

Kim Dokja didn’t miss the gap and asked.

[As I said, Han Sooyoung has never written a story about you existing like this. That means…]

Kim Dokja slowly raised his voice and spoke.

[Before Han Sooyoung wrote the novel, someone must have collected my 'soul'.]

[Nonsense.]

[Well. Whether this is nonsense or not, it seems like the beings behind you are explaining it.]

Kim Dokja could clearly feel it. The ominous and distant feeling behind the clone's back.

[Everyone, run away! Run away!]

The constellations surrounding them began to sway.

The absolute beings of the universe that made even those constellations tremble in fear.

There was something that held such a powerful aura that it could even be a threat to him, the 'Oldest Dream'.

[I wondered who they were.]

Kim Dokja frowned.

The abyss of this universe is vast. No matter how much he is the 'Oldest Dream', there are beings in this universe who escape his observation or live hidden between the lines.

Beings who are more afraid of being recorded than anyone else, and at the same time, who want to take over the record more than anyone else.

There were definitely those beings behind the clone right now.

[I don't know who tricked you, but you're being fooled right now.]

[It doesn't matter.]

[It doesn't matter? Really?]

Kim Dokja, who had been silently enduring, couldn't hold it in this time.

[There are people waiting for us. Are you thinking of betraying them?]

The clone he left behind was 'Kim Dokja' who existed for <Kim Dokja Company>. Kim Dokja couldn't accept the fact that such a clone refused to return to <Kim Dokja Company>.

[What those people want is you, not me.]

[You're me too.]

['You're me too'.]

The clone smiled subtly once again.

[I think it’s time for me to say that.]

[What?]

[What do you think 'real' is?]

[Are you suddenly going to have a philosophical conversation?]

[If having just a few more percent of memories is what separates 'real' and 'fake'.]

The tension slowly began to boil over in the clone’s entire body. The entire universe rippled and heated up dangerously.

[I think the 'clone' is you now.]

Kim Dokja nodded, watching Kim Dokja aim at him once again.

[Aha, so now the 'real' is you?]

Two Kim Dokjas aim their swords at each other.

Identical coats, identical Unbreakable Faiths.

The only thing that sets them apart is the meaning contained in those beliefs.

[You haven’t forgotten, have you? You’re not 51% anymore.]

Kim Dokja nodded with a grin.

[You’re not the 49% I knew.]

As if announcing the start of war, a meteor fell from somewhere.

「And the fight began.」

---

「Then who the hell am I?」

---

Goo Seonah clearly remembered the moment she first came into this world.

She was at the theater that day. She wasn’t planning to watch a movie, but to attend some fan event.

—Hey, this is my first time here.

She contacted her partner nervously at the theater entrance.

Her partner’s name was Go Jangwon.

His nickname was Go Janggo.

It was because he often said things that sounded like his head was broken.

—Go Jang. Where are you now?

—I took the subway

—What station

—Actually, I just got out of the house.

—I’m going to go back.

—Young-in, we can wait. You know?

—Just die.

While wondering why she had come to like this guy, she was very excited about today’s schedule. After today's event, they should eat something delicious together and go to a cafe and talk about novels all day.

With that thought, she opened the theater door. Not knowing what would happen to her after that.

"It still doesn't feel real."

Goo Seonah clenched and unclenched her fists several times while muttering bitterly to herself.

Several months had already passed since that day.

And she had changed a lot in those months. She no longer talked to strangers. When someone approached her, she was wary, suspicious, and even prepared to kill them if necessary.

It was a world where she couldn't survive if she didn't do that, and she survived.

「Only to meet Go Jangwon again.」

Goo Seonah looked down at the fallen Cheon Inho. No, he was no longer Cheon Inho. His appearance, his physique, and the items he was wearing now resembled 'Kim Dokja' more than anyone else.

[Story fragment 'A Certain Beginning' is shaking!]

Kim Dokja, who was injected with a story fragment, did not stop convulsing as if he had completely lost his senses.

「A Certain Beginning.」

It had been a few weeks since she had obtained this story fragment.

While she was hunting monsters as usual and absorbing the souls of readers who died during the scenario to gain strength, a familiar being appeared in her dreams.

【Honestly, I didn't know you would survive this far.】

"Representative Kim Dokja?"

The being I once met in a dream 'theater'.

"No, should I call you 'Asmodeus'?"

Goo Seon-ah was now able to see through his true identity. It was the result of gathering information from Ye Hyunwoo and other readers and making her own deductions.

[Oh. Am I already that famous?]

"What's your business?"

[I have a 'fragment' I want to give you.]

Goo Seonah obtained 「A Certain Beginning」 at that time. Unfortunately, most of the fragments were lost, so she couldn't obtain complete memories. However, it wasn't hard to guess what happened even with the legend with holes here and there.

「Kim Dokja and Kim Dokja fought.」

As a result of that confrontation, the 'Kim Dokja' she knew was torn into several pieces.

Goo Seonah looked down at the convulsing Kim Dokja.

Is this person really that 'Kim Dokja'?

Asmodeus, who gave her memories, described him like this.

【He is 49% Kim Dokja, the cause of all this.】

Goo Seonah quietly observed Kim Dokja. However, no matter how much she observed, she still felt like she didn’t understand.

The more she thought about it, the more things didn’t make sense.

If this guy was really 49% Kim Dokja, why did he lose all his memories and come here? No, wasn’t this guy a reader who had been living in reality with her and then possessed a character in this world?

What was most unsettling was that there was a subtle difference that she couldn’t explain between the '49% Kim Dokja' she had confirmed in her memories and the 'Kim Dokja' in front of her.

"Ah, I don’t know."

Goo Seonah slowly brought her hand to Kim Dokja’s neck.

She'll know if she absorbs it.

There was only one thing for sure. This man in front of her now had more 'Kim Dokja fragments' than she had ever collected. If she could get these 'Kim Dokja fragments', she would get closer to the one and only Kim Dokja than anyone else.

'Then I can find the cause.'

Goo Seonah took deep breaths.

Her hands kept shaking. This was because she had never taken the 'Kim Dokja fragment' of a living incarnation before. The 'Kim Dokja fragments' she had taken were all of the readers who were on the verge of death or had gone mad.

「"Take my memories."」

It was the same when she absorbed Christina.

Christina, who faced death while carrying out the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> scenario, entrusted the 'Kim Dokja fragment' she had to Goo Seonah.

She took on the burden. The more she embraced it, the stronger she became.

'You can do it. Come to your senses.'

Goo Seonah slapped her own cheek several times. She must do it. She must absorb it.

That's how she can become strong. That's how she can get her friend back.

In the end, Goo Seonah, who had made up her mind, reached out her hand once more.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' rejects you!]

A feeling of something biting her hand came along, along with a surge of excitement.

Tsk tsk tsk.

And Kim Dokja's memories began to come back. Some memories were sad, and some were painful.

There were also memories she knew.

「"Seonah-ssi. Don't make Inho-ssi too uncomfortable. He's not someone who would lie."」

The more she examined her memories, the more she felt that something was wrong.

Was it really the right thing to absorb this guy? Wasn't what she said actually right? Wasn't it necessary for someone to become the only Kim Dokja?

The moment she thought that.

[The story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear' begins its storytelling.]

Goo Seonah encountered a story in a corner of his memory.

「Yeong-in-ah. We can date. You know?」

It was the voice of Go Jangwon that she had been looking for.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 779 Episode 35 Demon King Qualifications (5)

---

The voice she had been searching for for so long.

Her fingertips trembled for a moment.

What happened?

Why was Go Jangwon’s voice coming from this guy?

「"Do you know how hard it was for me?"」

Goo Seonah gripped the handle of her sword as she heard that voice.

There was no doubt. This guy had killed Go Jangwon and absorbed him. Otherwise, how could she possibly hear such a story—

「"A good father? What should I do about that? I’m not even married yet and I don’t have any kids…"」

Goo Seonah hesitated and put down the handle of her sword.

Wouldn’t it be okay to listen a little longer, a little longer?

[The story 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear' continues its storytelling.]

Goo Seonah listened to the story over and over again. She wanted to hear just one more sentence. She wanted to know the truth.

What happened to Go Jangwon? What happened to him?

【You finally succeeded.】

When Goo Seonah turned her head in surprise, there was a doll standing in the rain forest where rain was occasionally pouring down.

Goo Seonah immediately recognized who he was.

"Asmodeus."

A spark shot out from the incarnation of the Demon King whose true name had been called.

"How did you get here?"

【Did you forget? I am also a member of the 'Gourmet Association'.】

Goo Seonah glared at Asmodeus without letting go of her tension.

"What's your business?"

Asmodeus smiled mysteriously and said.

【Killing Kim Dokja.】

"I'm sure you will."

【But you cannot take his soul.】

"What nonsense are you talking about?"

【You are not fit to hold his soul. You are not the main character. Don't you know that too?】

Asmodeus let out a somewhat theatrical sigh. Goo Seonah glared at Asmodeus for a moment and then slowly stood up.

"This guy is mine."

Goo Seonah thought as she looked down at the fallen Kim Dokja.

This guy has memories of 'Go Jangwon'. Until she reads all of those memories, until she finds out what happened, his soul must never be taken away.

【Ah. I see. You were looking for another 'reader'.】

Asmodeus covered his mouth and laughed as if he already knew everything.

【But you seem to be mistaken. The soul you were looking for is not in him.】

"How do you know that?"

【If you want to know the truth, kill him. And give me his soul.】

Goo Seonah bit her lip.

「"Re-reader-ssi!"」

The story was still ringing in her ears in real time.

Goo Seonah said while clenching her fists.

"No. There's still something I need to hear from this guy. So—"

[Hehe, anyway, Kim Dokja fragments—]

Again, a "tsk tsk" sound echoed through the air. And Asmodeus's incarnation began to be engulfed in sparks.

[You'll regret it. 'Theyare coming right now.]

They?

Before Gu Seonah could ask again, Asmodeus's incarnation faded.

[I could stop them, but for now, it's more fun to just watch.]

As soon as Asmodeus's incarnation disappeared, the nearby grass began to rustle. Those who emerged from the forest were faces she knew.

[Found it.]

The incarnations that were smiling strangely at her were there.

Students of Class B. The terminals of the incarnations of <Twelve Zodiac Signs>.

A rat that brought plagues. And a Snake That Cut Off Its Tail.

She also knew the owners of those incarnations. Once members of the Misreading Association, now they are the ones whose egos have been eaten by stories.

There are people who have maintained a similar relationship with her since their personalities changed.

But now.

The moment she saw them, a cold sensation ran up her spine.

Something is different.

[The Constellation 'Rat That Brings Plague' is looking at you.]

[The Constellation 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail' is looking at you.]

The fist that flew in in an instant pierced her stomach. She couldn’t rest properly. Blood burst out with a sound, and a sharp pain surged from her entrails.

[It seems much weaker than I expected.]

It felt like her neck would break at any moment in their grip.

'This can't be happening.'

The 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail' and the 'rat that brings plague' that she knew were already as weak as they could be. After fighting against Cheon Inho repeatedly and getting hit by the aftermath of the probability explosions, she was now so damaged that she could not properly carry out the scenario.

But where on earth did they get this strength?

[After all, I bought an expensive ancestral tablet and a modifier.]

Buying a modifier?

[The higher-ups must not have any space.]

Her heart sank.

According to the principle of the 'Recycling Center', there were two types of Constellations that could intervene in this battlefield.

One was the deep fires of the first class of <Sil-i-ji>.

And the Constellations of the 'Gourmet Association' that supported this high scenario.

However, there was one more way for the other Constellations to intervene in the world.

「What if someone bought the modifiers of the <Twelve Zodiac> Constellations that were floating?」

If those were the Constellations of the 'Giant Nebula'.

Sweat ran down her back.

In that case, the 'Recycling Center' was no longer safe.

[Ah, the guy we were looking for is over there.]

[That Heo Yeo Myeol Geon guy?]

If she opens the story once again and uses the 「Master of the Twelve Zodiac Signs」, will she be able to defeat these guys?

She wasn't sure.

Now, Goo Seonah didn't have much magic left. The previous fight had squeezed the story to its limit.

[Then what about this person?]

[Just kill her.]

The 'Rat That Brings Plague' pulled out its long claw and swung its weapon at Goo Seonah.

A blow that could neither be avoided nor blocked.

The moment she closed her eyes tightly, something heavy collided with her.

[Huh?]

The Constellation staggered from the powerful body slam and dropped Goo Seonah.

When she raised her head, a man with a sturdy build was blocking her way.

"Run away."

It was Lee Hyunsung, who had fainted a moment ago.

"Quickly."

Upon closer inspection, she saw that it wasn't just Lee Hyunsung. Kim Namwoon, standing next to Lee Hyunsung, pursed his lips and said, "Hey, it's going to be fun now."

Lee Jihye, who was next to him, could be seen unsheathing her sword.

"You, take that ahjussi and run away quickly. If he dies, Master will be angry."

It was strange. The [Daily Corpse] and [Hypnosis Incite] she had cast on the characters were completely destroyed.

Now, they had no reason to protect her.

And yet.

"Please."

Shin Yoosung held out her small hand and raised it to Goo Seonah.

"Please save ahjussi."

---

It was a terrible dream.

A dream where Kim Dokja and Kim Dokja aimed their swords at each other. A dream where I couldn't figure out why it happened or why it had to happen.

I floated aimlessly in the center of that dream.

The cracking sound of swords clashing. The sound of something being torn.

I groaned as I felt the vivid pain contained in that sound.

Why did they have to fight? Why does this universe have to exist?

「Youngest.」

Why did we have to be born as 'Kim Dokja'?

My back was wet. I opened my eyes, breathing evenly, and saw the dark cave ceiling.

When I raised my swollen body, I saw someone lighting a fire at the entrance of the cave.

"Goo Seonah-ssi."

She looked exactly like me, but with slightly more delicate lines, and she smiled with a feeble expression.

"What is this?"

"Well, as you can see."

Goo Seonah's appearance was a mess.

There were many new wounds that had appeared in the meantime. A long, torn side and a thigh where a chunk of flesh had fallen off.

What concerned me the most was her blood vessels that had turned dark red.

"What happened?"

"It'll be long if I explain."

Goo Seonah closed her mouth for a moment as if she was organizing her thoughts, and then began to speak.

"I think the Constellations of the giant nebula came in after purchasing the Zodiac."

"No way—"

"It’s not safe here anymore."

"You saved me?"

"…"

"Why? Wasn’t your goal to absorb me?"

Instead of answering, Goo Seonah lowered her head with a bitter smile. It seemed like she didn’t want to answer.

"And what was the memory you showed me?"

"What memory?"

"Kim Dok-ja appears in…"

"Oh, that one."

Goo Seonah picked up a branch hanging from the cave floor and threw it into the fire.

"I don’t know either. It’s not my memory. I got it from someone."

Goo Seonah groaned with her brow furrowed.

I quickly walked over to her and felt her pulse. There was turbid air flowing through her veins.

A blood vessel damaged by the 「Plague」.

Her veins were so severely damaged that they could not be repaired.

"Seonah-ssi."

Goo Seonah said as if she knew her condition well.

"Yes. It's a wound that can't be cured even if I eat 'Dae-Hwan-Dan'."

"We don't know yet. There's also 'Ellein Forest's Essence'—"

"I know. I've read it eight times. I said it can't be done. There's no way."

Goo Seonah shook my hand off as if she was tired and leaned against the cave wall.

Watching her dying in real time, I didn't know what to say.

Goo Seonah said as if she found my appearance funny.

"What are you so worried about? I was trying to kill you just a moment ago."

"That's because of a misunderstanding—"

"Misunderstanding…"

In the meantime, the forest of the demon tribe seemed to have entered a state of calm. The sound of the sickle swordsmanship heard here and there had faded, and no one could scream.

Maybe it meant that there were almost no students left.

"Do you know 'Go Jangwon'?"

I thought for a moment and shook my head.

"Is he a reader?"

"Yes."

I thought about the reader named Go Jangwon.

But I couldn't remember anything in particular.

"I read a little bit from your memory. Why, he was wearing some kind of military uniform."

Military uniform.

"Are you talking about Sergeant Jung Moonho?"

"Jung Moonho?"

"He was the one who possessed Jung Heewon's father."

Goo Seonah's eyes widened.

"I see. That guy was Jung Heewon's father. So that's why..."

Goo Seonah muttered "Jung Heewon" and "father" several times as if she was so happy.

"That kid is still a conscript, but he was a soldier here. Tell me more."

I told her about Sergeant Jung Moonho that I knew.

Goo Seonah listened to me without even a sound of breathing.

I wondered if that was the expression I had when I read Kim Dokja 'Ways of Survival'.

"That bastard went into the Beggar Sect? Ha, that coward."

Sergeant Jung Moonho, who became a servant of the Beggar Sect.

"What? Did he just get beaten up here too?"

Sergeant Jung Moonho, who ended up joining our side, but was beaten like a dog by the Beggar Sect's master in the first round of the non-combat.

"How was he in the end?"

Sergeant Jung Moonho, who threw himself to save his son, Jung Eunho.

A person who willingly sacrificed himself to protect the history of the characters.

「"Good job, Heewon-ah."」

I finally learned his name.

"Yes. That's right."

His name is 'Go Jangwon'

"The black hand took his soul in the end?"

I nodded.

She seemed to know who the 'black hand' was.

Hemoptysis continued once again, and black blood and stories began to flow out from Goo Seonah's body.

"They're here."

"Seonah-ssi."

I knew it too. I had been sensing ominous movements outside the cave since a while ago.

The number was two. Both of them had an energy that surpassed that of the upper-level demons. Maybe those guys were the Constellations of the 'Giant Nebula' that Goo Seonah had mentioned.

I hurriedly picked Goo Seonah up and started running.

How far could I run?

Should I use [Way of the Wind]?

If I call Yoo Joonghyuk or Jung Heewon, will they come in time?

"Do you know what to do?"

Goo Seonah said.

"If you don't do anything again, my soul will be taken away like Jangwon."

"I told you. I have no intention of absorbing you—"

"Have you ever thought about that? Whether we are Kim Dokja or not, it might not really matter. After all, the universe must have started from a single point."

"What the—"

"Just go back to that point. There's nothing to be scared of or afraid of."

An arrow flew from somewhere and grazed my calf, and I fell to the ground.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is mouthwatering.]

Goo Seonah reached out and grabbed my hand. Her memories of her slowly dying began to flow in.

「"Young-in, what are you looking at?"」

In that memory, a man was asking her.

「"A novel."」

「"Is it interesting?"」

The two looked at each other and laughed.

「"What is it about?"」

「"A story where the main character keeps dying."」

If everything was born from one point, would Go Jangwon and Goo Seonah be able to meet again at the end of this story?

The sound of thumping footsteps. The Constellations that were aiming at us were approaching.

"I have one request."

The power of the soul that flowed in filled my whole body.

"Kill the guy who stole Go Jangwon's soul."

My back which was carrying her slowly felt lighter. When I looked back, her body had already scattered. All that remained where she was was a single holy sword, 'Ravelinger'.

[You have obtained a very large 'Kim Dokja Fragment'!]

[Your remaining lifespan increases drastically!]

[A huge amount of 'loss' is recorded!]

I got up from my seat with Ravelinger in my hand.

I saw two Constellations running after harming the water.

[I finally found them.]

'Plague-bringing rat' and 'Snake That Cut Off Its Tail'.

To be exact, they were the ones wearing those masks.

Judging from the stories I felt, they seemed to be from <Olympus> or <Asgard>. They had incarnations at their sides. Lee Hyunsung, Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye, and even Shin Yoosung.

[Today will be a big gain.]

I could guess just from that how strong the Constellations were.

Historical-grade Constellations skilled in one-on-one combat.

They were the perfect cleaners to be dispatched to the Recycling Center from the 'Giant Nebulae'.

[The Constellations of the 'Gourmet Association' are saddened by your end.]

[The Constellations of the 'Twelve Zodiac Signs' are savoring your end.]

In the past, they would have been difficult enemies to deal with.

However.

[Your 'level' temporarily exceeds the scenario limit!]

[The Management Bureau is greatly embarrassed by the level you have!]

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite' is awakened!]

The story inside me was speaking.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is going crazy.]

The moment has finally come for me to inherit 'that power'.

A small horn rises through my head along with the magic flowing out of my body.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation (Agent)' reveals his true level.]

As if they noticed that the situation was taking a turn for the worse, the two Constellations rushed in, throwing the characters aside.

One was a magician. The other was a swordsman. Even when their weapons were right in front of me, I hadn't seen them.

What I saw was the other side of the distant sky.

Two Constellations hiding in the distant galaxy, wearing the shells of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs>.

[The Constellation 'Brothers of the Immortal' sense your gaze!]

[The Constellation 'Forgotten Monster Hunter' is astonished by your gaze!]

The two Constellations that received my gaze glowed fiercely.

I ordered them.

[Burst.]

The sound of a star exploding was heard across the distant universe.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 780 Episode 36 Real Kim Dokja (1)

---

There is a kind of secret information agency in <Nebula Olympus>. It is known to the world as the 'Hermes System'.

The core mission of the information agency is to collect big data and predict the 'big story'.

And to detect abnormal phenomena in lower scenarios in advance and eliminate elements that could pose a threat to <Olympus>.

[What happened to the Recycling Center?]

In response to Hermes' question, the information agency director 'First Hermaphrodite' confidently answered.

[It seems that the conquest will be over soon.]

[How?]

[I formed a team with the Historical-grade Constellations of the lower scenarios.]

Originally, the lower Constellations of <Olympus> were valuable resources to offset the probability of the scenario.

However, this time, since there was an issue , they had no choice but to replace the Historical-grade Constellations.

[The 'Recycling Center' will probably have restricted access by modifier.]

[I handled that part in a tricky way. Don't worry too much.]

[If It's a trick... ]

[It's a trick, but it's a safe way. I swear on my modifier.]

[Understood. You must obtain the 'Kim Dokja Fragment' there by all means. Otherwise, the Recorders will lose the right to record the 'only story'.]

As Hermes disappeared with a stern warning, the First Hermaphrodite—Hermaphroditus grumbled with a light sigh.

[Damn father. That's easier said than done.]

Of course, Hermaphroditus wasn't that worried even after saying that.

This was because the lineup of the special forces deployed to the 'Recycling Center' was by no means ordinary.

A raid force that included famous Constellations from the martial arts world, those who were sailors of the 'Argo' but whose fame was not widely known, and even forgotten Greek heroes.

With this level of power, even if a 'Narrative-grade Constellation' had appeared, it would have been enough to hunt them down.

No matter who was in the 'Recycling Center', it wouldn't be possible to stop them all.

[Who would be 'Kim Dokja'? I don't know who he is to do this, but…]

Even Hermaphroditus, the director of the Information Bureau, didn't know much about the name 'Kim Dokja'.

All she knew was that it was the real name of the 'Oldest Dream'.

That he was torn to pieces and scattered throughout the scenario area.

<Olympus> had to get their hands on the fragments before any other Constellation.

[An abnormality has occurred in the 'Hermes System'!]

That was when the Information Bureau's emergency light turned on. Hermaphroditus hurriedly ran to the situation room and called her secretary.

[What's going on?]

[That, that... I don't know for sure either!]

There were only three major incidents that had turned on the emergency light in the Hermes' system since she became the agent of the 'Hermes System'.

The first was when Hades, the 'Father of the Rich Night', and Poseidon, the 'Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Seas', collided.

The night sky reflected on the water. The dispute was over whether to acknowledge it as 'night' or 'sea', but fortunately, this was resolved well through Zeus' mediation.

The second time was when <Olympus>, <Vedas>, and <Eden> clashed over the copyright of the 'Resurrection Tale', but the situation that almost escalated into a war of nerves between Mythological Constellations was fortunately dramatically resolved with the appearance of copyright experts from each Constellation.

The last third time was when the 'Oldest Dream' was shattered.

Even she, the director of the Information Bureau, could only read a portion of the report related to this.

She only knew one thing for sure.

「That day, the 'Oldest Dream' they knew was discarded.」

Since the scale of the previous three incidents was enormous, Hermaphroditus couldn't help but be nervous the moment the emergency lights came on. The interval between flashes of the emergency lights shortened depending on the scale of the incident. For example, when the 'Oldest Dream' descended, the emergency lights flashed seven times per second, and when Hades and Poseidon collided, they flashed four times per second.

But this time, they flashed twice per second.

Judging from the flashing interval alone, the scale of the incident did not seem as large as the previous ones.

What was concerning was the color of the flashing lights.

'Yellow?'

Hermaphroditus's eyebrows furrowed as she looked.

The 'yellow light' was turned on when the 'Hermes System's' Information Bureau was in danger.

[Secretary!]

[Director! This way!]

Hermaphroditus ran straight to where the secretary's voice had been heard.

[Kueeeeek!]

The place where the screams were heard was the annex of the situation room. It was where the special department that had been in charge of the 'Recycling Center' attack was located a while ago.

[What the—]

Inside the department, Constellations wearing connecting goggles and diving inside the 'Recycling Center' were sitting in a row.

The 'Recycling Center' was a place that could not be entered without special network equipment. So there was no problem with the Constellations sitting there with their goggles upside down.

The problem was their condition.

[Kkaaaaaaaaa—!]

With a terrible scream, story of the Constellations wearing goggles began to drip out of their bodies.

[What the! Release the dive! Quickly!]

What could have happened?

The dive terminal provided by the Information Bureau was a Constellation device that ensured the safety of the Constellations when infiltrating the 'lower scenarios'.

As long as they were wearing this Constellation device, the Constellations would not be annihilated, but would lose their stories or suffer damage in the lower scenarios.

However.

[The Constellation 'Brother of the Immortal' enters a sudden extinction process.]

[The Constellation 'Forgotten Monster Hunter' enters a sudden extinction process.]

The Constellations were dying. It couldn't have happened.

The place they were deployed was at most the twentieth main scenario. Even if they had encountered a monster above the level of a legend, there was no reason for them to be in danger of death.

[Disarm the dive!]

They had to find the cause. And to do that, the most urgent task was to revive the Constellations that were disappearing.

[Disarm the 'Recycling Center' entry process! Hurry up—]

[Stop, it won't be released!]

[What?]

[The entire control system is down!]

The Constellations began to disappear one by one.

The total number of Historical-grade Constellations deployed in this operation was forty. If they had lost them all, it would have been a serious blow to the reputation of the Director of the Information Bureau, not to mention disciplinary action from their superiors.

However, the situation did not end there.

[The condition of the general agents of the Information Bureau is also strange!]

Along with the secretary's shout, the Surveillance Constellations located in the general department began to complain of pain.

[The condition of the Constellations that were monitoring the 'Recycling Center'—]

The Constellations were complaining of pain, pouring out words from their noses and mouths.

Hermaphroditus asked, unable to hide her bewilderment.

[What on earth... what on earth is going on? Has the 'One-Eyed Father' appeared? Is someone interfering with the 'Fate' we read?]

Of course, that couldn't be the case.

Even if a Myth-grade Constellation from another nebula had intervened, it couldn't have encroached upon the entire 'Hermes System'.

[Data screen! Where is the data screen!]

The screen that the agents of the Information Bureau were monitoring belatedly came to mind.

In the screen, there was an incarnation covered in the blood of the Constellations.

Hermaphroditus felt goosebumps.

That 'being' is definitely beyond the screen.

They are in a place where they can never be seen. But for some reason, Hermaphroditus felt like her eyes met his.

At that moment, Hermaphroditus recalled a face she had seen briefly while reading top secret materials.

Kim Dokja.

The 'Oldest Dream' that dreamed of this entire universe.

「Abandoned God.」

The god who should have clearly disappeared was ordering them.

"Explode."

---

The Constellations in the night sky were exploding like firecrackers.

One, two, three, four.

It was a scene that could be considered a scene of massacre.

Teacher Yang, who was watching the scene—the 'Demon-Like Judge of Fire'—said.

[We can't leave it like that.]

She was witnessing the death of the Constellations through the screen in the principal's office.

However, what she was worried about was not the dying Constellations.

[He'll die again.]

The white grim reaper who was mercilessly slaughtering those great Constellations. A man covered in the blood of the Constellations while his white coat fluttered. It was the agent of the 'Demon King of Salvation' who kept on destroying while continuously bleeding from his nose and mouth.

[That's right. But there's no one who can stop him now.]

The Mass-Producer looked at the screen with calm eyes.

A man was walking, engulfed in wild anger and sadness. It was unclear what was tormenting him so much.

However, it was clear what he was trying to do.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is going crazy!]

[The story 'The One Who Rewrites Fate' begins its storytelling!]

Common sense would tell you that the miracle the agent of the Demon King of Salvation was doing now was impossible.

In just the twentieth scenario, he was able to make a 'Historical-grade Constellation' explode with a single word? Not only was it impossible, but it was also an ability that even Myth-grade Constellations would not easily attempt.

And yet, the agent of a mere Constellation was violently wielding such an absurd power.

「This was possible because this stage was the 'Recycling Center'.」

All the Constellations that have now entered the 'Recycling Center' have lowered their 'level' to the limit.

In particular, all the Constellations that are bursting out now were beings that entered through the 'Hermes System' of <Olympus>.

The 'Hermes System' operates based on the 'Master of Skywalk's' story network. And Cheon Inho's [Incite] was a skill that spread at a destructive speed through the 'network'.

「"Explode"」

The sentence spread through the network like a virus, and gained momentous power by weaving countless stories during the propagation process.

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation (Acting Agent)' reveals his status!]

The ultimate [Incite] that combines Cheon Inho's [Incite] with Christina Page's [Daily Invoice] and [Hypnotic Incite], and even [Sentence Reinforcement].

「"Burst."」

All the Constellations of the 'Hermes System', which were lower in rank than the 'Demon King of Salvation', were unable to withstand the power of [Incite] and were entering a process of self-destruction.

[All the Constellations of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> can't take their eyes off of it!]

[All the Constellations of the 'Gourmet Association' gape their mouths!]

[Many Constellations are astonished by the power of 'Incite'!]

[The Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Olympus> can't hide their astonishment.]

Constellations bursting out from the distant universe as if a grand banquet was being held.

[Olympus will probably never forget that scene.]

The Mass-Producer and Uriel could not take their eyes off either.

[When this scenario ends, another great story will be born.]

Even though he knew that it was ultimately inviting Kim Dokja's downfall, and even though he knew that he was dying every time he uttered a word.

Just looking at the Constellations that were fleetingly falling at a single command, the Mass-Producer and Uriel had the same thought.

「I'll be able to see this story again.」

However, regardless of their wishes, the end of the scenario was approaching.

The maddened Demon King of Salvation's agent staggered along the forest path. He blew up the enemies who blocked his way, and continued his merciless destruction until he finally reached the deepest part of the forest.

The Mass-Producer muttered as if sighing.

[Now we'll know who the 'real Kim Dokja' is.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 781 Episode 36 Real Kim Dokja (2)

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With a special sound, the high-level demon fell.

Ye Hyunwoo retrieved the 'Kim Dokja fragment' that the high-level demon had.

['Kim Dokja fragment' retrieved successfully.]

The energy of the story flowing in with the message.

Ye Hyunwoo checked his face reflected in the puddle. The white and pale face that he had once seen on the cover of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』. It looked a bit younger than what he had seen then. Perhaps it was because his physical age was that of a boy.

「I wonder if I have become a little more Kim Dokja now.」

How many more 'Kim Dokja fragments' does he have to collect to become Kim Dokja?

Can he become Kim Dokja?

「"If you are possessed, you must hide behind me. You hate being hurt."」

A memory suddenly lingered in his ears.

Ye Hyunwoo thought of the owner of the voice.

'Noh Jiyoon.'

The daughter of Lee Dansu ahjussi. The girl who visited 'Kim Dokja Banquet' with him.

「Jiyoon is dead.」

No one told him that. However, he found out naturally while collecting the 'Kim Dokja fragments'.

「Everyone, get out of here! Quickly!」

There was a reader who fell at the same station as Jiyoon. Jiyoon fought the monsters to save the reader and the people, and died.

It wasn't that surprising in this world.

The reader Jiyoon saved that day also died in the end. Torn to pieces by a high-level demon.

What was the meaning of Jiyoon's sacrifice?

Ye Hyunwoo couldn't quite understand it.

「Just like how he couldn’t understand Kim Dokja, who risked his life for his group, while reading 'Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint' over fifty times.」

"You're right. I like being safe."

Replying to his old friend's voice, Ye Hyunwoo walked around. There was no road, but he walked where he thought it was a road.

He also hummed a song that his friend Jiyoon liked. As he hummed the song, memories that were still vivid enough to be called memories came back to him one after another.

[The story 'Panda and Friends' begins its storytelling.]

The story of persuading Gong Pildu to survive in Chungmuro.

The story of developing the 'Invincible Castle Tech Tree'.

The story of almost fighting Yoo Joonghyuk.

The story of 'capturing the flag' with the readers.

The story of meeting Cheon Inho and his group.

"But Jiyoon. You liked being safe, too."

Disaster scenarios and Peace Land, the Washington Dome and the 'Recycling Center'.

Hiding together in a brick house.

Eating soup made by the crane owner.

Fixing a swallow's leg or taking care of a goose in labor.

Watching the group from a corner while eating bamboo.

Counting each of those things, Ye Hyunwoo felt that all of those things were like a novel.

Then what role was he assigned in that novel?

Ye Hyunwoo's steps stopped. The forest ended and a small open space appeared.

There was a demon.

A man wearing a white coat and spreading his black wings.

Ye Hyunwoo swallowed as he looked at the red horns sprouting from his head.

[The demon '73rd Demon King' is staring at you.]

The '73rd Demon King' slowly turned his back and looked at him.

「Demon King of Salvation.」

He had expected it since he heard that the name of the demon was '73rd Demon King'.

That 'Demon King of Salvation' was here. The protagonist they were looking for had appeared as their opponent.

But the moment their eyes met, Ye Hyunwoo felt strange.

「That's the 'Demon King of Salvation'?」

He definitely felt the powerful energy of the 'Kim Dokja Fragments' from him.

But...

'Come to your senses.'

Ye Hyunwoo shook his head several times and took a deep breath.

'I have to kill him.'

Since he was marked as the boss of this stage, the 'Demon King of Salvation' must have powers of a different dimension.

He must not let his party face the 'Demon King of Salvation'. If he did, there would definitely be casualties. In order to prevent that, he came here before anyone else.

The moment he took a deep breath and stepped into the empty space, shouts were heard from all directions. The forest in the area shook and a group of incarnations appeared.

[Hit him!]

The incarnations who had drawn their weapons were running towards the Demon King of Salvation.

Ye Hyunwoo immediately recognized who they were. The Constellations of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs>. They were the ones who had participated in the scenario with them until recently.

[The Constellation 'Monkey That Fell From A Tree' roars!]

[The Constellation 'Ox of the Beginning' bares its teeth!]

[The Constellation 'Red Divine Army' roars!]

At first, it seemed like the <Twelve Zodiac Signs> were joining hands to hunt the demon.

But the wave pattern felt strange. The <Twelve Zodiac Signs> he knew did not have that level of power.

'It's not the Twelve Zodiac Signs'.

A cold sensation passed through his heart belatedly.

'Someone is using the modifiers of the <Twelve Zodiac Signs>'.

As if they knew the demon's weakness, the Constellations equipped with divine attribute weapons swung their weapons in precise trajectories. Push shot!

The demon tribe was mercilessly slaughtered by an attack that had the rank of a Constellation.

Looking at the staggering demon, Ye Hyunwoo's head went through complicated calculations.

It might have been a good thing.

The 'Demon King of Salvation' is a difficult opponent to face alone. If they wait for an opportunity here and join forces with the Constellations, the scenario will be much easier.

'Let's get started.'

From the start of the scenarios until now, Ye Hyunwoo has steadily progressed through the 'Invincible Castle Tech Tree'.

The 'Invincible Castle Tech Tree' he designed has a total of 10 stages.

And Ye Hyunwoo has just reached the activation condition for stage 8 of the tech tree.

[Activate exclusive skill 'Magic Charge Lv. 10'.]

The key to this build-up is to apply his exclusive skill, [Magic Charge] — to supply unlimited magical power to Gong Pildu, who has the strongest defense.

「But there is no Gong Pildu here now.」

Several Constellations that felt the magical wave turned to Ye Hyunwoo.

[That guy—]

[Don’t worry. He is an incarnation that can’t do anything alone.]

Is his weakness already known to the Constellations?

Ye Hyunwoo smiled bitterly.

They were certainly right. He is an incarnation that can’t do anything alone.

'But isn’t that the same for everyone?'

Ye Hyunwoo slowly took a deep breath and gathered his magical power. It was finally time for the 'Kim Dokja Fragments' he had collected to exert their power.

[The power of the new 'Kim Dokja Fragments' is activated.]

[Some of the skills of 'The Oldest Dream' are restored.]

The 'Invincible Castle Tech Tree' he had envisioned required 'Gong Pildu' up to stage 7.

However, it was different from stage 8.

[Activate exclusive skill 'Bookmark Lv.5'!]

[The composition of this skill is incomplete.]

[The characters that can be listed in the bookmark list are limited.]

「Bookmark」

A skill that is exclusive to Kim Dokja and can borrow the power of a 'character'.

It is currently extremely incomplete, so only one 'character' can be registered, but that was enough.

In the first place, he only needed one character.

"I will activate bookmark 1, 'Armed Fortress Master Gong Pildu'."

[Bookmark 1 has been activated.]

[The activation time is determined in proportion to the level of the bookmark skill.]

[Your understanding of the character is very high.]

[The activation time of the bookmark skill is partially adjusted according to your exclusive characteristics.]

[Activation time: 20 minutes]

The character that had been protecting him was now inside him.

[Activate exclusive skill 'Private Land Lv.10'!]

Gong Pildu's private land occupied the area in an instant.

However, this alone was not enough to activate the 'Armed Fortress'. This was because Gong Pildu's 'Armed Fortress' was not an exclusive skill, but a 'stigma'.

[Bookmark cannot borrow the 'stigma' of the person in question.]

Of course, Ye Hyunwoo had a countermeasure for that.

"I will fulfill the contract with the Defense Master."

[The Constellation 'Defense Master' activates the contract.]

A contract made with the 'Defense Master' in preparation for an emergency.

The contract was simple.

In exchange for granting the Defense Master's request, he would receive one of Gong Pildu's 'Stigmata' at a 'desired moment'.

[You have acquired the temporary use of 'Armed Fortress'.]

[The corresponding stigma will be converted to an 'Exclusive Skill' for the corresponding scenario.]

[Exclusive Skill 'Armed Fortress Lv. 8' has been activated!]

The ground beneath his feet rose and Ye Hyunwoo's body rose into the air.

The outer wall of the 'Armed Fortress' that would protect him from any attack was growing.

[What, what is this—]

A small castle that grew more than twenty meters in an instant.

It looked rather crude compared to the 'Armed Fortress' of Tech Tree Stage 10 that he was aiming for, but this was enough for now.

[The 'Moving Fortress' is activated.]

The fortress began to move along with the wheels that grew under the fortress.

[The 'Turret' of the Armed Fortress is activated.]

As the magnificent magic turrets aimed forward at once, the Constellations that felt a sense of crisis shouted.

[Didn't you say that guy can't do anything alone?]

[Damn it, finish him off quickly! If that guy steals the effective hit—]

Ye Hyunwoo sat on the castle's control tower while listening to the Constellations' screams.

[Activate the power of the item 'Shin Gijeon'.]

[The 'Turret's' arc destructive power increases!]

[The 'Turret's' shells have a tracking function added.]

The castle's radar activated and the dusty 'Demon King of Salvation' appeared in the field of view.

[Set the target of the strike.]

The 'Demon King of Salvation' had already suffered massive damage to its incarnation body.

Ye Hyunwoo, who had finally made up his mind, pressed the fire button.

The 64 turrets opened fire, and a loud noise rang out as if they were sweeping away the forest. The dust rose pitch black.

However, the scream heard within was not that of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

[Kuaaaaaaaah!]

The incarnations of the Constellations burst into pieces in the dust.

[The Constellation 'Monkey That Fell From The Tree' takes a huge blow and exits the scenario.]

[The Constellation 'Rabbit Without A Liver' takes a huge blow and exits the scenario.]

…

Even some of the Constellations could not withstand the blow and exited the scenario.

Even so, Ye Hyunwoo did not stop.

[You, why—]

The indignant Constellations aimed their weapons at him.

Looking at the Constellations running towards him, Ye Hyunwoo thought.

「Why did I do that?」

It was an unwise choice. Naturally, joining forces with those Constellations to end the demon and share the story would have been the safe choice.

However, the moment he saw the 'Demon King of Salvation' caught on the radar, Ye Hyunwoo could not make a safe choice.

「It definitely wasn't the Demon King of Salvation that he imagined.」

The face of the 'Demon King of Salvation' who had become a demon was as pale as a corpse.

A body like rags made of flesh. Eyes that had lost their light and skin that felt lifeless.

In the end, this scenario had to end by hunting him.

That's the only way to save the party.

He came here before anyone else for that goal.

Even so, the moment he saw Kim Dokja's face, Ye Hyunwoo felt faintly dizzy.

「I don't know if the author will see it. But I'll try it anyway. There's a spell I sometimes recite when I'm having a hard time.」

The enraged Constellations abandoned the demon and began to run toward the castle.

「I am Kim Dokja.」

Ye Hyunwoo knew it too. He is not Kim Dokja. He knew better than anyone that he was not Kim Dokja, so he recited that spell.

「But according to my friend, I resemble an octopus more than a squid.」

Ye Hyunwoo pressed the fire button again and again.

Piles of dirt scattered everywhere. The Constellations screamed in frustration amidst the broken pieces of wood.

[Kwaaaaah! Damn it!]

[Hold on! Wait until the bastard’s magic runs out! How long can he keep up this barrage —]

With the effect of [Magic Charge], magic power filled Ye Hyunwoo’s entire body once again.

The core of the Invincible Castle’s tech tree—the「Infinite Uroboros」system—was manifested.

[Eww!]

The Constellations that had been holding on firmly began to fall one by one.

Ye Hyunwoo’s inner self also gradually grew more certain.

They were at most the incarnation bodies of 'Historical-grade Constellations'. Even if the synchronization rate was increased in this 'Recycling Center' with limited rank, they would not be able to withstand the fortress' concentrated bombardment.

[Warning! The durability of the 'Armed Fortress' is decreasing!]

A thud was heard, along with the sound of something collapsing.

Startled, Ye Hyunwoo checked the radar. However, nothing was detected. Someone was attacking the fortress at a speed that could not be detected by the detection system.

Kugugugu.

The current 'Armed Fortress' was now only a level 5 fortress.

As powerful strikes continued, the outer wall of the fortress collapsed and cracks began to form on the inner wall.

The moment Ye Hyunwoo, who had lost some energy, recharged his magic power once again and activated the turret, something appeared, breaking through the control tower's defense wall.

[I didn't know that 'Armed Fortress' would be used like this. It's quite something.]

Three incarnations appeared. They were all guys he had never seen before.

The incarnation body of the Constellation at the forefront approached Ye Hyunwoo like a ghost and grabbed him by the neck.

[Why did you interfere with us?]

Ye Hyunwoo laughed, hanging in the air.

Even now, Ye Hyunwoo does not understand Kim Dokja, who sacrificed himself for the group.

However, even though he did not understand him, Ye Hyunwoo liked him.

The Constellation, who was quietly looking at Ye Hyunwoo hanging in the air, spoke.

[What you did just now wasn't courage, it was just foolishness.]

The moment he heard that voice, Ye Hyunwoo felt goosebumps running down his spine.

He realized something new.

The 'Invincible Castle Tech Tree Stage 8' was designed to withstand attacks from 'Historical-grade Constellations' inside the 'Recycling Center'.

But if they had broken through this wall and entered, it was clear what kind of enemy they were.

'Narrative-grade Constellation'.

The ominous sparks that surged through the air proved it.

He couldn't understand it. How did a narrative-grade Constellation intervene in the scenario of this 'Recycling Center'?

[The worldview is unstable due to the aftermath of excessive probability.]

[Many Constellations are watching the 'Recycling Center'.]

He could feel the gaze of the stars watching this place from the vast distance of space.

How many Constellations are watching this place?

[The worldview rules of the 'Recycling Center' are weakened.]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> starts to move!]

[An unidentified nebula interferes with the probability of the 'Recycling Center'.]

Olympus? Asgard? Vedas?

Or a small nebula that was hidden?

The moment he saw the aftershock of probability that brightly colored the empty space, Ye Hyunwoo intuitively felt that this scenario had completely left his hands.

[You also have a fragment of the oldest dream.]

"Bam-"

[This is really strange. Why do all the incarnations with this fragment invite death…]

Feeling a hand tightly squeezing his neck, Ye Hyunwoo intuitively sensed his end.

「"Kim Dokja, I will become him."」

Considering his boastful words, he felt that it was a vain end. At the same time, he also thought that this was a very fitting end for him. Perhaps, ever since he first saw Cheon Inho in Chungmuro, he had a feeling this day would come.

He couldn’t become Kim Dokja.

There was someone in this world who was much more suited to Kim Dokja’s place.

His role was to play the role of an extra in the lines that no one would remember.

However, if there was one last regret, it was this.

「I really wanted to say thank you. I’ll come back to see you again in a few days.」

That he couldn’t keep the promise he left in that comment.

As the powerful magic flowed through the Constellation’s hand, his consciousness began to fade.

If he died like this and became a fragment of Kim Dokja, would he be able to meet Jiyoon again? Would he be able to laugh and talk about this story when they met again?

Look, if you really possess someone in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', you'll die right away. Saying that—

Would he be able to not regret reading this story?

Ye Hyunwoo waited for death with such thoughts.

However, no matter how much time passed, his consciousness did not disappear. He felt his body floating in the air, and someone was holding him and putting him down on the floor.

He slowly opened his eyes and raised his head, and saw someone's back.

[The <Star Stream> intervenes in the probability aftermath of the area.]

[The probability scale moves.]

Is it Kim Dokja?

But when he looked again, he was wearing a black cloak.

So is it Yoo Joonghyuk?

No. He was smaller than Yoo Joonghyuk.

Ye Hyunwoo noticed the words written on his back.

『OLD SCHOOL』.

Old School.

The boy wearing the cloak looked back at him. The moment he met those eyes that felt strangely stubborn, Ye Hyunwoo thought he knew who he was.

That's because he had read this story fifty times.

"You... look like my Dokja-hyung."

A being who could move the 'probability scale' against those scary Constellations.

"Thank you for saving my hyung."

<Kim Dokja Company> came to the 'Recycling Center'.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 782 Episode 36 Real Kim Dokja (3)

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When the invitation from the 'Recycling Center' came, Gilyoung thought the moment he had been waiting for had finally come.

Even if it was a trap, it would be fine. If only he could meet his hyung one more time.

"Don't move. If you use that, I'll really kill you."

When Lee Jihye warned him, pointing to the invitation fluttering in the air, Lee Gilyoung made a stern expression.

"Why? It was for me."

"You don't know what will happen if you go there right now? Do you know what's there?"

"Hyung will be there."

Lee Jihye lightly muttered, and Lee Gilyoung's head was pounded.

"Wake up. What are you going to do when you go there?"

"I'm pretty strong, too."

"Even if we're strong, it's not a place where we can exert 100% of our strength."

"Still—"

"What if you go there and have an accident?"

"I won't. "

"Are you confident that you can handle it if the probability is all tangled up? Do you know why your master and your older sisters and brothers hesitate to intervene in the world line? Why don't you go there and cause some aftershocks? What if the scenario gets messed up and everyone dies? And if Dokja-ssi never comes back—"

"Okay."

"What?"

"I get it, so stop."

Lee Gilyoung lowered his head and pursed his lips. Lee Jihye looked at Lee Gilyoung for a moment and then lightly touched his shoulder.

"I know how you feel."

"…"

"Wouldn't I want to go there too? You have to talk to your older sisters and brothers first. So don't have any random thoughts and just stay still. Okay? "

"…"

"Answer."

"I got it."

Lee Jihye looked at Lee Gilyoung with anxious eyes for a moment, then sighed and disappeared toward the control room.

Lee Gilyoung looked up at the message fluttering in the air.

[An invitation has arrived.]

[The filtering is partially removed.]

[Someone has invited you to the scenario 'Philia Academy'.]

[Through this scenario, you can meet the 'Demon King of Salvation' once again.]

[Would you like to accept the invitation?]

He read the message over and over again. He reached out and turned his hand back several times.

"F---..."

Lee Gilyeong, who had been hesitating, eventually gave up and swore.

He knew it too. In fact, Lee Jihye's words were right. He shouldn't act rashly here.

Let's wait for Jihye noona to come back. Don't cause trouble alone again.

I shouldn't ruin everything because of my mistake.

Lee Gilyeong walked somewhere while thinking about such things. The place he headed to was the training room located in the basement. Among them, the 'Room of Time' that was recently created.

Lee Gilyeong, who liked comics, named the room.

「Time flows slowly in this room.」

He named it himself, but it was Lee Gilyoung's first time entering this room.

A room that was remodeled to resemble the 'Time Fault' of the Dark Dimension, and a place called the 'Tower of Nightmare' in another dimension.

The moment he stepped into the portal of the room, Lee Gilyoung's breath was caught in his throat.

The feeling of inhaling compressed air. The overwhelming density of time that weighed down his existence.

That guy must be the only one training in a place like this.

Lee Gilyoung approached the equipment rack in the corner of the training room. There were the relics and SSS-grade equipment that <Kim Dokja Company> had collected so far on display.

True horse.

Dain Sleif.

Bingryun Hwan.

…

From the report of <First Martial Arts> to the relics of Norse mythology, the projectiles used by the previous king…

A weapon he knew well was hanging in the center of countless weapons.

Cheonchongun Sword. The blade was sharpened to be used at any time, as befitting its owner's temperament.

To the right of that sword was another sword.

Unbreakable Faith.

The last weapon Kim Dokja used. However, the sword was in a state that belied its name, broken.

Looking at the blade with less than two bones left, Lee Gilyoung reached out to the hilt.

A blade that had not been sharpened for a long time.

Lee Gilyoung gripped the hilt tightly and drew a trajectory in the air.

Kim Dokja saved his companions several times with this sword, but he was never able to save himself.

「Kim Dokja cut the 'Oldest Dream' with this sword.」

To be exact, he failed to cut it, and the sword broke in half in return.

Lee Gilyoung did not know what Kim Dokja was thinking while holding this sword.

However, Lee Gilyoung seemed to understand Kim Dokja at the moment when he was about to cut his own childhood.

"Wrong."

Hearing a voice from the darkness, he turned his head in surprise and saw a man in dark clothes standing there.

Lee Gilyoung answered bluntly, adjusting his handle of the sword.

"Then what are you going to do?"

Yoo Joonghyuk motioned to the empty space without saying a word. Then, the 'Cheonchongun Sword' hanging on the wall floated up and was sucked into Yoo Joonghyuk's hand.

In the martial arts world, it is called Heogongseopmul.

Lee Gilyoung let out a loud noise.

"If you came here to show off your crude skills—"

A brilliant sword light cutting through the darkness.

Lee Gilyoung swallowed his words without realizing it at the sight of that precise trajectory.

A sword strike like a scattering meteor.

Yoo Joonghyuk's history was contained in that fleeting line. Cutting down countless constellations, dropping them, and eventually collapsing the sky that the constellations were hanging on—

Does Yoo Joonghyuk remember everything he cut down to reach that trajectory? The thought of injustice came to him again, and a faint sense of despair followed.

He looked pathetic in front of the overwhelming history that Yoo Joonghyuk had lived through.

"You sooty bastard."

Lee Gilyoung asked Yoo Joonghyuk, who was swinging the Cheonchongun Sword without answering.

Why are you so strong?

Yoo Joonghyuk drew the same trajectory several times and answered calmly.

"You just have to wake up at a set time every day and go to bed at a set time."

"What nonsense are you talking about?"

"Use your day regularly. Make your body develop habits before your will."

"Aside from those self-help books, aren't there any other ways?"

In fact, he didn't ask the question because he thought he would get proper advice. He just wanted to hear something right away and calm his complicated thoughts.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk thought about something for a moment and said this.

"Regret often."

"Regret?"

"I think about the things I could have changed if I had been a little stronger."

He didn't expect to hear such an answer, so Gilyoung answered in confusion.

"I do that all the time."

"Regret it better."

To be honest, I thought Yoo Joonghyuk, of all people, would have a special mentality.

Everyone regrets. Things they couldn't keep. Things they couldn't change.

Gilyoung had such memories too. However, Gilyoung was now afraid to recall those memories.

"What if my emotions wear out?"

"You have to make sure they don't wear out."

"So what."

The Cheonchongun Sword stopped in midair.

Yoo Joonghyuk stared at the point where the blade was pointed and answered.

"Every morning when I wake up, I think I've been reborn."

"What are you talking about? Do you want to receive birthday wishes every day?"

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't answer after hearing that.

A line steadily drawing across the air.

Looking at that line, Gilyoung felt strange.

Maybe Yoo Joonghyuk was still regressing. Even after the trait of the regressor disappeared, isn't he still repeating the regression that no one knows about?

"You should do the same."

"What?"

"Take the sword."

"Are you going to try it now?"

Gilyoung, holding 'Unbreakable Faith', growled. In the darkness, the two new forms intersected, and a cracking sound rang out.

Naturally, the one who fell was Gilyoung.

"Cowardly bastard! I don't know how to use a sword!"

"Get up."

Gilyoung shouted and charged. 'Unbreakable Faith' forcefully slashed the air, and Yoo Joonghyuk lightly swung his sword.

Gilyoung, who rolled on the ground again, shouted.

"What is this! You're using a strange trick right now!"

"I just swung the sword."

"Don't make me laugh! You hit me so hard!"

"Again."

Gilyoung got up and attacked several times. He swung his already broken Unbreakable Faith. His breathing became increasingly difficult and his heart pounded wildly. An unknown elation began to flow through his body.

As they clashed their swords again and again, Gilyoung asked.

"If I keep doing this, can I become as strong as you?"

"No."

"If I really, really work hard."

"…"

"If I practice harder than you are practicing now! Then!"

The Unbreakable Faith and the Cheonchongun Sword clashed, creating black and white magic waves.

The two entangled blades answered for Gilyoung and Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Will I ever be able to save Kim Dokja?"

Gilyoung did not say anything more, and Yoo Joonghyuk did not listen. Nevertheless, the same sentence was engraved on the history of the two.

"If you work that hard."

Yoo Joonghyuk pointed the blade at his ankle.

"You might be able to catch up to this much."

"You rascal."

Lee Gilyoung laughed in vain.

"How much longer would it take to go up a little further?"

"With your talent, it would take a hundred years."

A hundred years.

Considering the time Yoo Joonghyuk had trained with the sword, it was a very generous assessment. To YooJoonghyuk, a regressor, a hundred years was 'just a hundred years'.

However, it was different for Lee Gilyoung.

"That's too late."

"..."

"That's too late. It has to be now."

The two blades clashed once again, and 'Unbreakable Faith' that Lee Gilyoung was holding flew into the air.

Yoo Joonghyuk reached out with his other hand and snatched the sword.

"That won't work."

Lee Gilyoung, whose sword had been taken away, asked in a bewildered voice.

"Then what should I do?"

"Regret. And become stronger. You're still young, so you can do more things you'll regret."

Yoo Joonghyuk, standing firm in the darkness, threw the Cheonun Sword. The sword that had spun around like a snail landed right in front of Gilyoung.

Gilyoung blankly looked down at the sword.

"There are still people here who will accept your foolish actions."

When he suddenly raised his head, Yoo Joonghyuk had turned his back.

Gilyoung looked at his back, then looked down at the Thousand Cloud Sword that Yoo Joonghyuk had thrown. Then he bit his lips hard and lightly wiped his eyes, saying,

"You sooty bastard."

"..."

"I'll be back. Just tell my noonas."

With those words, Gilyoung, holding the Thousand Cloud Sword, ran out.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the entrance where the boy had disappeared, then looked up at the pitch-black ceiling of the training room for a moment.

He calmly walked out of the training room.

Someone was waiting for him at the entrance to the training room.

"You should have blocked it."

It was Yoo Sangah.

"It was a dam that would burst someday."

"What if you threw a bomb at a dam that would burst someday?"

A portal swirling like a storm could be seen far outside the window.

A portal to another world line—the 41st round.

Lee Gilyoung jumped in without even a moment of hesitation, kicking the ground.

"I gave him special permission. That guy was born anew today."

"What are you talking about?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at the Unbreakable Faith left in his hands and said.

"There's another person who'll regret tomorrow."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 783 Episode 36 Real Kim Dokja (4)

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The air of the scenario he had been breathing for the first time in a while. Feeling the familiar yet unfamiliar density, Lee Gilyoung recalled the old advice of Kim Dokja.

「"That's right. Just breathe like that, exhale, and repeat slowly."」

It was the breathing method that Kim Dokja had taught Lee Gilyoung, who had once wanted to learn martial arts.

「"What kind of method is this?"」

When asked, Kim Dokja scratched his cheek as if he was embarrassed and answered.

「"It's just a deep breath that I take before reading a book. It helps me concentrate."」

Yoo Joonghyuk criticized him for saying, "The teachings of a fool who doesn't even know martial arts," but after that, Lee Gilyoung often recalled that breathing method whenever something happened.

Inhale slowly, exhale.

「"I think that each breath is engraved with a story."」

「"A story?"」

「"The story of people who lived before us."」

Breathing in the same way as someone you respect. The breath didn't make Lee Gilyoung particularly strong. However, just by following the breath, Lee Gilyoung felt like he had taken a step closer to Kim Dokja's world.

This is how Dokja hyung breathed and lived.

"Breathe slowly."

Lee Gilyoung said as he patted Ye Hyunwoo's back as he exhaled roughly.

"Breathe, exhale. Keep going."

Watching Ye Hyunwoo slowly lose consciousness, Lee Gilyoung thought about the reason he had come to this scenario once again. The reason he had to endure the aftermath of probability and the criticism of his colleagues to come here.

「Lee Gilyoung had something he wanted to ask Kim Dokja.」

That's why he came without a plan.

He accepted the strange position called 'Old School' and came here even while accepting the scenario penalty.

However, once he actually came, he didn't know who to ask.

Who is the real Kim Dokja?

Is it this boy who resembles his hyung's younger self? Or is it that woman who gave off a similar vibe to his hyung? Or is it the man who resembles his hyung the most?

Or is it the monster who seems the furthest from his hyung but whose soul he can sense?

[The demon '73rd Demon King' is staring at you.]

The demon looking at him with blank eyes.

Looking at that demon, Lee Gilyoung realized what Lee Jihye said.

Maybe his only hyung is gone now.

[Who are you?]

Lee Gilyoung asked the Constellation that was asking him.

"This is the question I want to ask. Why are you here?"

[Do you know who we are?]

"Hongik."

The moment he said that name, the Constellations' faces changed for the first time.

[The Nebula, who has not revealed its identity, reveals its name!]

[The Constellations of <Hongik> reveal their existence!]

[How do you know us?]

"It's strange that I don't know when such stories are flying around." Lee Gilyoung was not Kim Dokja, but he breathed and thought like Kim Dokja.

Then he was able to see the world like Kim Dokja.

He slowly blinked his eyes and felt their stories. In particular, the faint sound of drums coming from the Constellation that occupied their center.

Lee Gilyoung opened his mouth as he listened to the sound that sounded like falling raindrops hitting the ground.

"The 'Master of Rain'?"

Master of Rain.

One of the three Narrative-grade Constellations that serve 'Seoninwanggeom', the owner of <Hongik>. The rain god who controls the rain in the sky at will—Woo Sa.

[You really know me.]

Woo Sa nodded, surprised by Lee Gilyoung’s keen eye.

[That’s right. I am the Master of Rain, 'Woo Sa'. Who are you?]

"I’m just a student who missed my graduation period."

Woo Sa pondered for a moment what that meant and then asked.

[What does that mean?]

"I don't know the details, but how did you guys get in here when you're not even students? The Recycling Center is probably closed."

[I have no obligation to answer a rude person.]

"Hmm. I see. So you borrowed the power of the ‘Founder’s Mother ' to get in? Oh, you don't have to answer. Judging from your expression, it's true."

<Hongik>'s Narrative-grade Constellation, Founder’s Mother —Ungnyeo.

Ungnyeo was closely related to <Twelve Zodiac Signs> as she was born a bear.

What if Ungnyeo made a contract with <Twelve Zodiac Signs> and thus borrowed the modifiers of the twelve branches in <Heungui>?

"Did you sneak in here by stealing the modifiers of the weaklings?"

[We didn't steal them. We—]

"Aha, you're in a cooperative relationship?"

The picture was roughly drawn.

The 'Recycling Center' was a playground woven by the Gourmet Association and the Management Bureau. In the end, in this scenario, the great Constellations of the <Twelve Zodiac> are bound to become playthings.

So the <Twelve Zodiac> also made a decision.

If they are just going to be playthings no matter what, they should borrow the power of other <Nebulae>. That way, they should find a way to achieve their long-cherished desires.

"Monkey That Fell From A Tree! Primordial Cow! Red Mountain Army!"

Gilyoung called out the names of the Twelve Zodiac Signs that had lent <Hongik> modifiers, one by one.

"Are you listening? You won't get what you want that way. How long are you going to live relying on other Nebulae? Why don't you think about standing up for yourself even once?"

With the sound of Tsut...sparks flew out from Woo Sa's body and the other Constellations.

<Zodiac> Constellations respond to Lee Gilyoung's words

[If you keep interfering with us, we have no choice but to eliminate you.]

"You? Me?"

[I don't know who you are—]

Woo Sa raised his hand toward the sky with those words. The dozen or so Constellations that had joined forces to attack the demon flew into the sky.

Only to eliminate one person, Lee Gilyoung.

Lee Gilyoung said, looking at the shadows of the Constellations that filled the sky.

"That's right. It seems you don't know who I really am at all."

The Cheonchongun Sword that emerged from Lee Gilyoung's arms glowed. As the magical energy that gushed out from the boy's heart entered the sword, soon a strong energy of more than ten meters filled the air.

[What the—!]

Lee Gilyoung is not good at swordsmanship.

He doesn't know martial arts properly, and he has never learned it.

However, he has seen things over his shoulder.

The way the people he admires fight.

When and how they swing their swords, how they use their magical energy, and how they control their strength. Lee Gilyoung saw all those scenes and replayed them countless times in his head.

One replay became two, and two soon became three, four, five. He replayed them again and again, how many times did he replay them?

Lee Gilyoung thought.

「I think I can do it too.」

Lee Gilyoung's imitation.

「A trajectory that shatters the sky with one blow.」

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.

With a loud roar, the sword strike of Cheonjongun Sword split the sky. Woo Sa, who barely managed to block the sword strike while swinging both hands, shouted.

[Oh my God. Could it be that you—]

Lee Gilyoung's sword relentlessly cut the sky. It cut and cut again. It cut so hard that the sky really split. The screams of the Constellations echoed everywhere. The violent lightning struck and swallowed up even the screams of the Constellations.

[Woo Sa! I have never heard of such a monster—]

When one of the Constellations, who had become thoughtful, shouted, Gilyoung stopped his sword for the first time.

"You were like that in our world line, and here, too, you are really disappointing."

The Constellations fell like hail, making a sound like corn.

One, two, three, four. The Constellations that lost limbs to the swordsmanship cried out in pain.

Gilyoung looked down at the Constellations and said.

"How long are you going to live only coveting the stories of future generations? You have many good stories too."

[What?]

"What you call 'showing us a good example for future generations'. Isn't that the spirit of Hongik?"

Woo Sa looked down at the fallen Constellations. Although some had lost arms or legs, none of the construction had suffered fatal blows to their bodies.

The attacks clearly avoided vital points.

Woo Sa looked down at the Constellations and at Gilyoung, who still had not put away his sword.

Woo Sa hesitated for a moment and asked.

[Could it be that you are a friend of the 'Oldest Dream'?]

Lee Gilyoung slowly nodded.

Woo Sa muttered with a sigh.

[Were the words of the Myth-grade Constellations true...?]

"What?"

[Thank you for showing mercy in my hand, friend of the Oldest Dream.]

At Woo Sa's signal, the incarnations of the Constellations all released their possessions.

「The context of the misaligned modifiers returned to their proper places.」

The Constellations of <Hongik> that had entered the 'Recycling Center' by borrowing modifiers were returning to their original places one by one.

"Goodbye, and give my regards to the Mother of the Founder."

Until the last moment, Woo Sa looked at Lee Gilyoung with a dumbfounded expression, but he disappeared without a trace.

Only after Woo Sa's figure completely disappeared did Lee Gilyoung finally let out a breath.

"Thank goodness he's a guy who can communicate."

Is it because of the scenario penalty? Even though he only used his magic power for a moment, the penalty was enormous.

[The scenario penalty will consume your entire body!]

If Woo Sa had really rushed in, Lee Gilyoung would have had no choice but to release the limit.

If that had happened, there would have been a big problem with the probability of this world line. Anyway, he thought he could take a breather with this.

[That’s amazing.]

Clap, clap, clap— Applause resounded. When he turned his head to where the sound came from, someone was standing there.

[As expected, it’s the <Kim Dokja Company> that lives up to its reputation.]

A unique sarcastic tone of speech.

An incarnation wearing a pitch-black cloak like Lee Gilyoung was there.

[After intimidating the Constellations with the bare minimum of force to suppress the aftershock, you sent them back with just your words… If Kim Dokja had seen it, it would have been a sight he would have praised.]

"You."

A much more terrifying magic flowed out from Lee Gilyoung's entire body.

"Asmodeus."

With those words, Gilyoung's new form disappeared. Gilyoung's right hand, which shot out like lightning, collided with Asmodeus's left hand. A rough magic wave exploded, and the two new forms moved away at the same time.

"You planned it? My hyung ended up like this—"

[Hmm? Who are you referring to when you say 'hyung'?]

Asmodeus answered with a dark smile.

[There are so many of your 'hyungs' here.]

"Where is Sooyoung? Wasn't Sooyoung's disappearance your doing?"

[Oh my, Han Sooyoung died because of me?]

"Sooyoung's not dead!"

[She died crushed by her own sins.]

Gilyoung swung his Cheonchongun Sword with a sigh.

Asmodeus smiled after confirming the magic contained in the sword strike.

[You've become quite skilled at handling magic. But isn't this your limit?]

As Asmodeus lightly snapped his fingers, a dozen or so high-level demons hiding in the bushes rushed in.

They were Constellations belonging to the Gourmet Association.

Gilyoung asked mockingly.

"Are you trying to deal with me like that?"

[Why? It won't work?]

"It seems you've forgotten who I am."

The high-level demons rushing in were all individuals that could not be underestimated.

Gilyoung didn't hesitate any longer.

"Release the limit."

It didn't matter if it caused a probability aftershock. If they don't eliminate Asmodeus here right now, they'll have bigger problems later.

Gilyoung decided that.

'Help me!' He asked his sponsor.

The demon who was once his sponsor.

'The Ruler of the Bottomless Pit.' As soon as the power of a Mythical Constellation radiated through his entire body, the <Star Stream>, which had detected the abnormality, reacted.

[The <Star Stream>'s probability is moving!]

Lee Gilyoung also knew. If he uses this power, his incarnation body will also be in danger.

But if it's just for a moment.

If he kills Asmodeus and sweeps away the Constellations of the Gourmet Association in this moment.

Kukuaquaquaquaqua!

Hellish yellow locusts poured out from Lee Gilyoung's left hand. Yellow worms of the demon god that devour all living things in the world.

[No, I know who you are. Lee Gilyoung.]

"What?"

[Insect Lord. Ruler of the Kings of the Cultivated. Contractor of the Demon God Abaddon!]

Asmodeus was laughing.

[Hahahaha! Confined Demon God! Go wild more! Soak yourself in the atmosphere of the scenario you have returned to after a long time!]

Lee Gilyoung's expression hardened. Lee Gilyoung, sensing something was wrong, grabbed his left hand with his right to retrieve the yellow insects.

"Abaddon."

But Abaddon did not stop.

"Abaddon! Stop! Abaddon!"

The yellow insects that poured out soon devoured the Constellations and even the incarnation of Asmodeus. And soon, they began to rush toward the '73rd Demon King' who was looking at them from afar.

"No! Abaddon! Stop! Stop!"

The yellow insects that rushed in began to gnaw at the Great Demon's entire body.

"You, he is not the enemy! He is not the enemy!"

Lee Gilyoung struck his left hand that was pouring out the yellow insects, and struck it again. How many times did he strike?

Only after his left hand became covered in blood did the yellow insects that were pouring out slowly stop moving.

But the Great Demon's entire body was already covered in a swarm of yellow insects.

"Hyung."

Lee Gilyoung approached him like a crazy person.

That couldn't be happening. He didn't come to this world to see this.

That was when the sky collapsed and the gigantic dam of probability burst.

A huge aftershock of probability was blowing around the place where the Great Demon was.

「The <Star Stream> always balances the scales.」

Abaddon is a 'Mythical-grade Constellation'.

Now that Lee Gilyoung has manifested this power, the <Star Stream> will move the scales that are appropriate for his status.

There were no Constellations moving beyond the sky. No one outside of this scenario dared to step onto the scale opposite to the Demon God Abaddon.

Still, his left hand trembled uncontrollably. The Demon God coiled inside him was warning him.

「Run away, kid.」

Lee Gilyoung had never heard Abaddon say that.

[The demon '73rd Demon King' is rising in status!]

A dazzling light began to flow out between the yellow insects along with a message coming from somewhere.

[The demon '73rd Demon King' rises in rank!]

[The demon '73rd Demon King' rises in rank!]

…

How many times did the same message ring out? The nearby yellow insects melted away, and something was seen walking out of the grave of insects.

「The one who was on the other side of this scenario from the beginning.」

Lee Gilyoung blankly watched the scene.

[The demon 'Demon King of Salvation' descends!]

Time seemed to pass slowly. His heart pounded violently.

There was the one he had wanted to see so badly.

The Demon King, who was none other than the one he remembered, was there.

"It's been a long time, Gilyoung."

He felt dizzy the moment he heard the voice. The boy's heart was testifying. His hyung was there.

"You've grown up well."

But the moment he thought of that, Lee Gilyoung felt terrible fear.

"Hyung, no."

He wanted to see Kim Dokja. But on the other hand, he didn't want to meet him here.

This was because Lee Gilyoung knew better than anyone what it meant for the being that disappeared in this <Star Stream> to return.

[The scenario content has been updated!]

The Demon King smiled as if he understood the boy and asked.

"Do you still remember how to deal with a Demon King?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 784 Episode 36 Real Kim Dokja (5)

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He felt dizzy as if he had been shot.

"Gilyoung-ah."

The voice that Gilyoung remembered.

The man who moved in the way he wanted to be like was speaking while holding a sword.

"You have to remember."

Gilyoung couldn't move even a single step as he watched the Demon King of Salvation walking toward him.

The Demon King of Salvation slowly drew his sword and aimed it at him. The blade fell like the second hand. When the blade finally reached Gilyoung's forehead.

"What are you doing!"

Someone pushed him away and shouted.

It was Ye Hyunwoo, who he thought had fainted.

He rolled around on the floor as his choked breath released and he got up. He could see Ye Hyunwoo, who had fallen to the floor, retching.

Ye Hyunwoo, with a pale complexion, looked up at Gilyoung and spoke in a desperate voice.

"Come to your senses—"

With those words, Ye Hyunwoo fainted again. Looking down at such a Hyunwoo, Gilyoung bit his lip.

Yeah, he has to come to his senses.

Gilyoung looked at the Demon King of Salvation again.

That is not Dokja-hyung. There is no way Dokja-hyung would attack him.

Then the Demon King of Salvation smiled.

"Now you remember."

The determination he had barely managed to hold onto wavered in front of that smile.

Gilyoung's senses were speaking. That expression, that look in his eyes, that gait. There was no doubt. That was the 'Demon King of Salvation' he remembered.

「Has Kim Dokja never attacked him?」

He had not.

Gilyoung had already experienced this fight once.

In their tenth scenario—'The 73rd Demon King'.

"What the... What the, why!"

Gilyoung held the Cheonjongun Sword while repeating the same words. Even so, Gilyoung could not swing the sword.

"No. I don't want to fight. Dokja-hyung! Please!"

What if the sky shatters when he swings his sword? What should he do if the star hanging in the sky falls?

[The Great Demon King, the 'Demon King of Salvation' unleashes his power.]

A sword strike that flew in when he was not prepared. 'Unbreakable Faith' was right in front of him.

Lee Gilyoung reflexively blocked the sword, recalling the moment he faced Yoo Joonghyuk. His wrist felt like it was breaking from the heavy impact.

「"You all remember how to deal with the Demon King, right?"」

He remembers.

He definitely remembers it even now.

But he didn't want to remember it.

「"From now on, you must hunt me."」

The memory of having to kill the person he loved more than anyone else.

"How could I remember that!"

Lee Gilyoung shouted in a fit of rage.

The Demon King of Salvation smiled silently.

「"Gilyoung. This time, you can think of it as a game."」

A game. Kim Dokja always said. This world is a game. You can think of it as a game. Lee Gilyoung followed the teachings.

He carried out the scenario without any guilt. He defeated monsters and sometimes killed people.

He survived.

In return for surviving, he learned something.

This world is not a game.

「"Even if I die, I will come back to life. I promise."」

Lee Gilyoung repeated his actions while looking at the new form of the Demon King of Salvation, shaking.

"I don't know how to kill my hyung. I've forgotten all about that!"

Lee Gilyoung tried his best to push away the approaching Kim Dokja. He released the magical power he had accumulated and swung his sword in a clumsy trajectory.

[The Constellation 'Ruler of the Abyss' roars!]

In the end, Abaddon used his power once again to protect Lee Gilyoung.

The magical power released like a storm.

The Demon King of Salvation, who reacted to that magical power, also released his own power.

[The great Demon King 'Demon King of Salvation"s power rises!]

Tsutsutsut, a spark of probability struck down along with the sound. The sky, which had lost its day and night, blinked repeatedly, and the pitch-black darkness of the universe spread through the cracks in the sky.

[The restricted channel of the 'Recycling Center' is temporarily opened!]

The sky of the Recycling Center was collapsing.

[Constellations of external channels are temporarily flowing in!]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> are staring at the 'Recycling Center'!]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Vedas> are staring at the 'Recycling Center'!]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are staring at the 'Recycling Center'!]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Hongik> are staring at the 'Recycling Center'!]

…

The Constellations' gazes seeped through the cracks in the split sky. The stars that could not see the 'Recycling Center' due to the ban were peeking at the hidden world.

「This is the place where all stories are recycled.」

Amidst the pouring gazes of Constellations, Gilyoung swung his sword.

"I..."

He shouted, drawing a path that was too clumsy to cut any Constellation.

"What I remember is...!"

The Cheonchongun Sword and his Unbreakable Faith clashed once again. The cracking sound flowing from the swords that met. A story blossomed from the gap between the swords.

「Excuse me for a moment.」

The first person to give him a grasshopper.

「All of Gilyoung's stories began at that moment.」

With that one insect, Gilyoung gained life and received life.

He was reborn.

That's why the boy's birthday was the day all the tragedies began.

A story flowed out every time the cracking sound echoed.

「Are you a god, hyung?」

The person who was once his god.

Now Gilyoung knows.

He was not a god of this world.

「"I'm neither a god nor a protagonist. Rather, I've always envied the protagonist."」

Now, Gilyoung understands the feelings of Kim Dokja who used to say that. He's old enough to say that, just a little bit.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' is unable to continue speaking.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' sighs.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' is silent.]

What Gilyoung remembers is Kim Dokja's small back from behind the group.

His back as he protected the group against the pouring meteor shower.

「"Hyung, don't you make a wish?"」

That day, while watching the meteor shower falling from the rooftop of the theater dungeon, Gilyoung made a wish.

Please don't let him die. Please let me see the end of this world with him.

「And the <Star Stream> granted Gilyoung's wish.」

The man died several times because he wasn't a god, and came back to life several times even though he wasn't a god. In that death and resurrection, the man became a myth.

People praised him and the Constellations sang about him.

But Gilyoung knew.

「I asked to see the epilogue of a certain novel.」

He was actually just an ordinary man who loved stories.

"Hyung! Please!"

Gilyoung swung his sword, remembering the man. He released his magic power to get the man back.

Every time the magic power accumulated in the sword surged out like a wave, Gilyoung felt like he was being pushed somewhere, or that he was leaving somewhere.

He swung his sword harder, more desperately because he hated that feeling.

「The child who loved bugs is now approaching adulthood.」

Like a talent that had been hidden, Gilyoung's magic power overflowed in all directions.

Abaddon's magic power blossomed in his swordplay.

Gilyoung, who had cornered the 'Demon King of Salvation' in an instant, unleashed the momentum of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] like a storm.

A copycat style. Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship Season.

Breaking the Sky Ryu Seong-gyeol.

Just as a tree that has grown repeatedly stretches out its branches, Lee Gilyoung's talent in full bloom invaded the sky of Constellations.

Breaking the Sky's swordsmanship swept across the entire body of the Demon King of Salvation. 'Unbreakable Faith' fell to the ground, and one of the Demon King's knees, unable to withstand the shock, buckled.

Lee Gilyoung approached him, catching his trembling breath.

"Hyung."

Looking down at Kim Dokja who was looking up at him, Lee Gilyoung also slowly knelt down on one knee.

Their gazes were of the same height.

The Constellation that had seemed so far away was now close. Now he could ask. He could ask the old question.

「Why did you save me back then?」

However, when he met Kim Dokja's eyes, what came out of his mouth was unexpected words.

"I want to make that wish again."

A meteor was falling from the split sky. Constellations dying somewhere. Looking at the tails of those Constellations.

"I don’t mind if hell starts again. I don’t mind if it’s not a happy ending. I don’t mind if I don’t see you often. That’s okay, please—"

"…"

"Can’t you just be a normal person?"

He prayed to the man who had now truly become a god.

"Just for one day, just be a normal person…"

He prayed and prayed, thinking of the man who loved this story.

He saw a few more Constellations falling from the sky.

The Demon King of Salvation, who was looking up at that sky, opened his mouth.

"There are so many stars."

The moment he heard the voice, Gilyoung realized.

"Just say you understand."

He knew before he said it. His wish couldn’t come true.

Because that wish was a story that the stars didn’t want.

It was a story that went against the probability of this damned <Star Stream>.

Gilyoung thought as he watched the Demon King of Salvation smiling sadly.

Maybe the reader really wanted to die back then. Maybe he wanted to breathe his last in the story he loved. "I'm sorry I don't remember how to kill my hyung."

With a clear sound, Cheonjongun Sword fell to the floor.

The boy who grew up watching Kim Dokja only knew Kim Dokja's methods.

[You are 'Old School'.]

[You cannot play a decisive role in this main scenario.]

The Demon King of Salvation answered him.

"Gilyoung-ah."

The Demon King of Salvation stood up and grabbed 'Unbreakable Faith'.

"Get up."

"…"

"The scenario isn't over yet."

Gilyoung shook his head as he watched 'Unbreakable Faith' slowly aiming at him.

"No, it's over."

Perhaps he came all the way here for this moment.

To be forgiven for his sin of not being able to save Kim Dokja from eternity.

"My scenario ends here."

[The Constellation 'Ruler of the Abyss' protects his incarnation!]

As the 'Blade of Faith' moved, Abaddon's magic flowed out from the center of his heart and formed a barrier.

The 'Blade of Faith' collided with the barrier. The sword strike dug in with a cracking sound. At the moment when the sword strike finally reached the heart, Gilyoung felt as if time had stopped.

The world's scenery became colorless and someone's voice was heard.

「Lee Gilyoung.」

The tone of speech was different from the Kim Dokja he knew. Nevertheless, Lee Gilyoung felt Kim Dokja in him.

「Breathe slowly. Breathe, exhale, yes. Slowly.」

Lee Gilyoung listened to his words as if he was under a spell.

He felt someone lightly embracing him and pulling him away from the Blade of Faith.

A breathing sound that felt close. It was a breathing method that Gilyoung knew well.

「Do you remember when we did this breathing method?」

Gilyoung nodded.

'Before reading the story.'

「Then you should read the story now.」

'No, my story is already over.'

「You haven’t met an 'ordinary Kim Dokja' yet.」

Gilyoung tried to answer.

There is no such Kim Dokja.

This world does not allow such a Kim Dokja.

Then a voice spoke.

「It’s just that it hasn’t been written yet. That’s why you couldn’t read it.」

Gilyoung raised his head as his consciousness faded. His heart began to beat again.

Who could it be?

Who could be saying these cruel words that rekindled the hope that had already been extinguished?

「So just wait a moment.」

Another Kim Dokja was there.

「I’m going to write that sentence from now on.」

Gilyoung nodded.

---

[Exiting 'Snowfield'.]

With a groan, the snow scattered from my breath.

I lightly wiped the snow from my lips and placed Gilyoung, whom I was holding in my arms, on the floor.

Gilyoung, lying next to Ye-hyunwoo, looked like brothers.

Brothers.

When I slowly raised my head, I saw the face of the Constellation I had been searching for for a long time.

[Many Constellations are watching you.]

[The 'Recycling Center Director' is watching your choice.]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus>…]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard>…]

…

[The amount of 'loss' you've collected has reached a certain level!]

[Your incarnation cannot handle your stories!]

[Your stories react to your emotions!]

[Your incarnation is in danger due to excessive use of power!]

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' warns you!]

…

Ignoring the messages coming in real time, I endured the upheaval with the power of [Incite].

The passionate sadness, anger, and pain were all suppressed under a single sentence.

「It's Kim Dokja.」

I greeted the only man in the world who could understand this pain.

"It's been a while, hyung."

The Demon King of Salvation nodded.

"Youngest."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 785 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (1)

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「The ending of 『Infinite Instructor』 is unknown. Because it was never written down.」

---

A lightning bolt struck Killer King as he roamed the forest. Then, a high-level demon fell down with a thud.

"Oh! Another one!"

"That’s amazing."

As Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu cheered, Cha Yerin shook her head.

Killer King shrugged and shook his shoulders at the group’s reaction

"It’s nothing."

The ability to defeat a 'high-level demon' without even a single scratch. What was more surprising was,

"A word is enough for those guys."

Killer King really defeated them with just 'a few words'.

Killer King’s method of defeating the high-level demons was simple.

"Judging by your appearance, your original form must have been insignificant."

[W-what nonsense are you talking about! What do you know about me—]

Tsutsutsut!

"If you're so confident, reveal your true identity."

[I'm from the great <Olympus>— Egegegege! Why, why— Gegegegegegege!]

Tsutsutsutsut!

The name of this worldview is 『Infinite Instructor』. Every character here has their own role, and therefore can only speak within the established categories.

Simply put, in this worldview, speech that doesn't fit the worldview's composition is not permitted.

What happens if you ignore the worldview and keep speaking?

[Egegegegegegege!]

That's what happens.

"Wow, my goodness."

At first, she thought it was luck.

But then, one, two, three, four of the high-level demons who fell like that... Soon, when they surpassed ten, Kyung Sein's eyes filled with awe.

"Here, kill... no, Kang Ilhoon is the strongest."

Killer King snorted as he watched Kyung Sein, who couldn't hide his admiration.

"They're weak and lost."

In this worldview, the trait given to Killer King was 'Delusionist', and the delusionist was the only being in this worldview who could 'say anything'. It didn't matter whether he directly mentioned the <Star Stream> or the true names of the constellations.

Everything he said was 'delusion'.

How many demons had he tormented with probability like that?

"Everyone, get out."

For the first time, a high-level demon who didn't become a probability roaster appeared due to Killer King's provocation. It wasn't because he was strong.

[The restraining power of the worldview is weakening!]

The restraining power of probability in this world was weakening.

He didn't know why.

Was it because he exploited the trait of the worldview?

The next moment, a light flashed in the distance and the sky opened up. Even the running Killer King, Cha Yerin, Kyung Sein, and Lee Dansu, were speechless for that moment and looked up at the sky.

Constellations were falling from the universe beyond the sky.

The high-level demons who had been chasing th em fell to the ground, and from somewhere, a huge probability aftershock was heard.

It was a scene that made both the delusional and non-delusional people think of the same name for that moment.

"Kim Dokja."

They muttered, not even knowing who that name was calling anymore.

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rlaehrwk37: It's finally starting

---

I wrote a graduation speech as a valedictorian in high school. As it turned out, I was the winner of the 100-day award that year, and I was chosen as the valedictorian. The Korean teacher's comment when he first read my speech is still vivid.

"You wrote it well, but um. What should I say... You should write it like yourself. Don't you think so?"

"Like me? What is that?"

"You want to be a writer?"

Was it because of my nineteen-year-old self, or was it because of my teacher's provocation?

When I first heard that question, I had a strange attitude from the beginning.

What is being like me?

How does that person know what is 'like me' in the first place?

The question I had at that time naturally became forgotten as time passed. It wasn't that I forgot after finding the answer. I forgot naturally because I was too busy, or because I made excuses that I was past the age to ask such questions.

Now, more than ten years later, I felt like I knew the answer I had been searching for for so long that day.

That's what being like me is.

A Demon King with a similar appearance to me. A pale face was there.

He was a being from the same roots as me. A constellation who loved stories more than anyone else in the world. My sponsor and my hyung. The one who told me who Kim Dokja was.

I opened my mouth to him.

"Hyung, let's stop now."

Even as I said that, I already knew the answer I would get. I answered before hearing the answer.

"...If I could really stop just by saying that—"

"This story wouldn't have even started in the first place."

Watching him insist on answering, I felt that he was still my sponsor.

We smiled at each other.

"You look terrible."

"Hmm. You've gotten taller, haven't you?"

"You are actually satisfied with your own face?"

"It's not bad in the bathroom."

I thought about my sponsor, the 'Demon King of Salvation.' Not the Demon King of Salvation who repeats the same sacrifices every time in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', but the Demon King of Salvation I know.

For example, the awkward greeting we exchanged when we first met.

「Hello.」

I still remember that tone of voice that didn't sound like Kim Dokja at all. He was someone who was subtly different from the Kim Dokja I remembered from 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

I learned a lot from him.

「Do you know Ways of Survival?」

I read the long and boring 'Ways of Survival' through his relic.

「Phew, I slept well.」

I learned the shamelessness of buying a pillow with someone else's coins and resting.

「Okay, let's go check out the back of Joonghyuk's head in the 41st Round.」

I learned how to hit the back of the head of the innocent Yoo Joonghyuk.

「I maintained the Constellation modifier, but I couldn't pay for the Demon King modifier.」

I learned the tenacity to boldly sell off even his own modifier when necessary.

Is that all?

He even stole the share of his incarnation just because he didn't have any coins...

"It was fun. Wasn't it?"

He smiled brightly, knowing what I was thinking and what story I was thinking about.

"Yes, it was fun."

I really wanted to ask him so many things. As time passed, some questions lost their meaning, and some were naturally resolved.

And some questions remained between the lines. We each pulled out our weapons as if to bring out the questions that remained between the lines.

"That sword."

I said while looking at the sword held by the Demon King of Salvation.

A sword that looked like 'Unbreakable Faith' to anyone.

"It's mine."

However, I knew that the sword was not 'Unbreakable Faith'.

"It's mine now."

The Demon King of Salvation waved his sword in the air.

[The Holy Relic 'Thoughts About Almost Everything' hums. ]

The Holy Relic I had lost as I entered the Recycling Center.

The 'Thought' that could change into anything as long as the conditions were met burst into tears in the Demon King of Salvation's hand.

"You should have guarded it well."

"If you find a lost item, please return it to its owner."

"Owner?"

The sword in my hand was the real 'Unbreakable Faith'.

The sword used by Han Sooyoung when she visited this world line.

I felt strange. This sword was the weapon of the 'real Kim Dokja'. But now, the one holding 'Unbreakable Faith' is me.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' smiles.]

My stomach kept churning.

It wasn't easy to face him smiling. For the first time, I felt like I didn't want to see the next page.

"You caused a great accident."

"I learned it from my sponsor."

We looked up at the sky at the same time. The only scenery we could share, as we had to aim our swords at each other.

"There are many Constellations today, too."

"It's always been like that."

The galaxy of the dazzling <Star Stream>.

The falling stars and the unfalling stars were looking at us.

"That's why we have to fight."

Was I the first to activate [Way of the Wind]? Or was it him? I don't know.

But when I came to my senses, we were standing on [Way of the Wind].

"It was good that we put Gilyoung to sleep."

"That's basic. I don't want him to fight you who has become a Mythical Constellation."

Standing in the center of the swirling wind, he did not show overwhelming force unlike when he confronted Lee Gilyoung of <Kim Dokja Company>.

[The Demon King 'Demon King of Salvation"s power decreases.]

The aftershocks have decreased compared to before.

It was natural. Now his opponent is not Lee Gilyoung, but me.

The scale of the <Star Stream>, which had tilted abnormally, returned to suit my ability.

"Hey, let's see how much the Youngest's skills have improved."

The power has dropped to a similar level to mine. Even so, he is still a Constellation protected by the scenario. He was a star more powerful than any Constellation I have ever fought.

Scream!

We stretched our swords toward each other. The blows that could kill each other crossed.

I know that neither of us wants to hurt the other. Nevertheless, this confrontation had to continue.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> watch your battle.]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> watch your battle.]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Vedas> watch your battle.]

The [White and Blue Sword] embedded in each other's swordsmanship tore through the air with a sharp sound, and nothing was cut.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' watches your battle.]

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' watches your battle.]

[The Constellation 'Reclining Dragon' watches your battle.]

[Many constellations watch your battle!]

However, my heart, which had not been cut, ached.

"If you do not control the stories, you will live as the stories wish. Have you forgotten?"

Then the Demon King of Salvation laughed.

"Sometimes, it is not bad to live being pushed by the stories."

I looked down at Gilyoung, who was lying on the floor.

"You speak like a Constellation."

"Because I'm a Constellation."

[The Constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' makes a displeased expression.]

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' closes her sad eyes.]

[Some Constellations show hostility toward the Demon King 'Demon King of Salvation.']

I bit my lips as I heard the voices resenting him.

He was the final boss of this scenario. He was a disaster designed to protect this forest and kill the students of the academy.

The stitching marks that remained on his body were proof of that.

"You used the body of the demon that was in Washington East."

The body of a Marquis-level Demon.

It was the very Demon that once impersonated the 'Demon King of Salvation.'

"This guy was also the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

That damn Demon King of Salvation.

I asked with a bitter smile.

"Isn't it time for that 'Demon King of Salvation' to stop?"

"That can't be. Without that name, I'm nothing."

"How long will you be the 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

"Until there's only one person left."

The Demon King of Salvation knows how this story will end.

And so do I.

"I don't want to write that kind of story."

"From now on, what you have to write is an 'impossible story'."

"The story you like, hyung?"

My sponsor smiled as if satisfied with my answer. When I couldn't meet his gaze, I lowered my head, and the Heavenly Sword that had fallen to the ground was emitting a

white light.

"Yes."

There is only one way to solve this scenario.

「From now on, I have to kill my sponsor.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 786 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (2)

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Can I win?

I don't know.

Actually, I've never thought about it.

"Youngest."

In this world, fighting that 'Kim Dokja'—and Kim Dokja who became a Constellation at that. This is something that no one but a crazy person would ever do.

"You could die, you know?"

"Isn't dying our specialty?"

And yet, why am I doing something like this?

"No, our specialty isn't dying."

"It's dying and coming back to life."

Is this also proof that 'Kim Dokja's legend' is flowing to me?

"You can't come back to life. You built both your traits and legends wrong."

"So you think I'm going to die?"

The Demon King of Salvation smiled quietly without answering.

I answered that smile.

"I'll be the first Kim Dokja who will never die."

The Demon King of Salvation burst into laughter, perhaps because my words were funny.

"I'm looking forward to that"

Please look forward to it. Because right now, I need the support of even just one more 'Kim Dokja'.

[The demon 'Demon King of Salvation' reveals his status.]

Above the blade-like wind, we exchanged sword strikes as if on cue.

When the [Way of the Wind] I compressed exploded in the sword fight, Kim Dokja also responded with his skillful [Way of the Wind]. The magical powers of both sides were canceled out, creating harmony in the air.

The tale of the Demon King of Salvation seeped through the clashing blades.

[The story 'Distorting Things as One Pleases' has found a story to distort.]

[The story 'King of a Kingless World' begins its storytelling.]

「This is a world without a 'king' right now.」

As the story began its storytelling, the form of 'Thought', which had been disguised as 'Unbreakable Faith', changed.

「His sword was born rejecting all the thrones of the world.」

'Thought' soon took the form of ″'Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword'. The day the legend 『King of a Kingless World』 was created, the very sword that destroyed the 「Absolute Throne」.

Cold sweat ran down my back.

If I faced that sword, even a Constellation would die. In fact, Kim Dokja had a precedent of defeating Constellations from the 「Twelve Zodiac Signs」 with that sword.

The Demon King of Salvation warned.

"You know? This legend cannot be accepted unless you are a 'King'."

With no time to answer, the Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword sword flew at me.

I swung the 'Unbreakable Faith' that I held with both hands with all my might. With a bang, my body was pushed back. The solid sentences of the legend were transmitted as a shock.

I felt it once again. What kind of life he had lived, what kind of legend he had built.

What he was made of.

But I couldn't just give in here.

"Have you forgotten whose agent I am?"

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation (Agent)' reveals his status!]

Of course, the Demon King is also a 'King'.

[Your modifier resists the effect of 'King of a Kingless World'.]

I took out the real Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword from my inventory to confront him and said.

"And I didn't clear the 'Absolute Throne' carelessly either."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' begins its storytelling.]

I recalled the story of that day once again. It was a day I didn't want to remember.

「The day the Lord of the Throne descended between the lines of the world.」

The story of the day I met the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' outside the scenarios.

「In the distant void, there were two people who confronted the Lord of the Throne.」

I thought of Han Sooyoung.

I thought of her words as she disappeared to hand me this sword and this story.

「"Why did you want to be a writer?"」

As if answering that question, I swung my sword.

"If you are Kim Dokja who destroyed the 'Absolute Throne'—"

The Constellation of the shining Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword flared up.

"I am 'Kim Dokja' who killed the bastard who created that 'Absolute Throne'."

Kim Dokja. This story exists just to prove those three syllables made up of consonants and vowels.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' protects!]

[The story 'King of a Kingless World' growls!]

The two stories resonated and howled.

The balance of the stories that had been neck-and-neck began to tilt at some point.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' goes crazy!]

「King of a Kingless World was a great story. It was a story that was created by destroying the 'Absolute Throne', with a solid sponsor, story, and sentence structure. However, even if it is a story about the same 'Absolute Throne', it is different.」

「Heir of the Eternal Name was a tale born from a more impossible incident that touched the foundation of the world.」

Above all, 「King of a Kingless World」 is a legend, while 「Heir of the Eternal Name」 is a Semi-mythical tale that is continuously growing.

The power of the overflowing tale engulfed the Demon King of Salvation. Even as he was helplessly pushed back, the Demon King of Salvation did not lose his composure. His expression seemed to indicate that he had expected this much.

"I guess you've already forgotten. Who was with you when that story was made?"

Even in the midst of the storm of stories, the Demon King of Salvation did not lose his dignity.

As if he knew that this story could not harm him.

When he gently swung his sword as if cutting through the clouds, the sentences of the story that had been covering him split apart as if by magic.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' frowns.]

It was an expected result. This story cannot harm him. 「Heir of the Eternal Name」 is a story that I completed when I made a contract with the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

It's a story that couldn't have been born without his help in the first place.

[The power of the story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' does not work on the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

The Demon King of Salvation, who completely nullified my story, looked at me.

"Just kidding."

"Let's really empty it."

Since we're both readers, we can't strike back with a half-hearted story.

[The Constellation 'The One Who Brought Ten Lambs' watches the battle with anxious eyes.]

[Some Constellations are expecting an even fiercer battle!]

The <Star Stream> won't be satisfied with this kind of fight either.

He knows it and I know it.

We're the ones who are more familiar with directing than anyone else in the <Star Stream>.

The moment our eyes met, we realized what skills each other would use.

[The amount of 'loss' you have acquired is sufficient.]

[Exclusive trait 'Record Repairer' is activated.]

[Exclusive skill 'Bookmark' is additionally repaired.]

[The function of the exclusive skill 'Bookmark' has been strengthened!]

[The level of the exclusive skill 'Bookmark' has increased significantly!]

A series of characters came to mind.

I chose one character without hesitation.

The Demon King of Salvation was the same.

"Bookmark number 2."

"Bookmark number 5."

Characters in different bookmarks. However, what we called was in a sense the 'same character'.

"I will activate 'Judge of Evil' Jung Heewon."

"I will activate 'Judge of Destruction' Jung Heewon."

The two Jung Heewons were possessed by each other.

One is Evil. The other is Destruction.

One is a judge who exerts herstrongest power only on 'villains'. And the other side is the judge who exerts the strongest power only on 'monsters'.

It was the moment when the match that could never come true came true under the name of 'Kim Dokja'.

Kuwagwagwagwa!

The moment the sword energy and energy collided, a sound that seemed to burst my ears.

A scene of sword fighting that could not be followed with the eyes.

I and the Demon King of Salvation held our breath and endured the power of Jung Heewon that we had read.

"Hmph."

Every moment I swallowed my breath, a fierce battle of wits took place. Twenty, fifty, eighty. As the sums increased, I could feel the trajectory of the reading that the Demon King of Salvation had read from Jung Heewon's sword fighting.

「When Heewon-ssi uses her sword, move your arm like this.」

「When using a superior sword, always use an honest and precise thrust.」

I could not lose either.

「Heewon-ssi has a habit of taking a step back every time she catches her breath.」

「Faster, stronger. Heewon-ssi's sword was more intense than this.」

This is the readers' battle. The one who reads more fiercely and bookmarks more meticulously wins the battlefield.

I was gradually out of breath.

It was hard to follow the interpretation of Jung Heewon by the Demon King of Salvation. To be honest, I was impressed.

They really are different.

Jung Heewon in the 1,864th Round is really amazing.

But it seems that the Demon King of Salvation was also impressed.

"It's quite good. Heewon-ssi in the 41st Round is also very strong."

"Whose sword is it?"

Just as Jung Heewon in the 3rd Round became Kim Dokja's sword, Jung Heewon in the 41st Round became my sword.

"The one who swung more swords than anyone else to protect us."

The moment when different interpretations met at the same conclusion, the clashing blades made a loud noise once again.

A situation where life and death were at stake in a single sword strike.

Even so, we were laughing.

"Heewon-ssi is really an amazing person."

"She's a great person."

"If it weren't for her, I wouldn't have been able to see the end of the scenarios."

"I'll probably have the same story someday."

This fight is fun.

"That Heewon-ssi has a peculiar habit of her right foot."

"That Heewon-ssi is so honest in her swordsmanship."

This time of sharing stories that I like is so enjoyable. As the interpretation continued, sentences that could kill each other flashed through my mind one after another.

I want to show him this interpretation. I want to share this story that I know with him.

That greed made me throw a decisive move.

[Activate 'Time of Judgment'!]

Jung Heewon of the 41st Round is the 'Judge of Destruction'.

Just in time, the 'Demon King of Salvation' in front of me was the 'Demon King' of all monsters.

「It's not enough yet.」

Jung Heewon of the 41st Round has more overwhelming talent than any other Jung Heewon of any other world line. [Bookmark] alone is not enough to show that.

[Exclusive skills 'Bookmark' and 'Incite' are silent!]

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.10' is activated!]

「I am Jung Heewon.」

The path of the sword opened in my head, and all the Jung Heewons I know were embedded in my body.

The best 'Jung Heewon' that I can recreate now was swinging the sword.

Will the Demon King of Salvation accept this interpretation? Will you be able to break the history we have built?

"You really read hard."

Even in front of the flying blade, the Demon King of Salvation was still Kim Dokja.

"This is the first time I've seen a Heewon-ssi like that."

"If you stay still like that, you'll die!"

"Die?"

The moment he snickered, the scenery around me felt a slight ripple.

"Aren't you underestimating your brother?"

The sword I swung bounced up with a loud cracking sound.

[Time of Judgement, Gwisal, and Jung Heewon's strike with the power of Kendo.]

The Demon King of Salvation accepted that strike. How?

[The Great Demon King 'Demon King of Salvation' activates 'Time of Judgement'!]

I opened my eyes wide.

There was no way. 'Jung Heewon', who the 'Demon King of Salvation' had borrowed just now, was the 'Judge of Evil'.

And the 'Judge of Evil' could only be used when the opponent was an 'evil person'—and only with the consent of the Constellations of the 'absolute good' lineage.

Now he was a 'Demon King'.

No Constellation of the 'absolute good' lineage would lend him their power.

But how—

For a moment, I felt strange. My hair stood on end, and my spine creaked.

I felt death drawing near.

I reflexively took a dozen steps back, and the surrounding scenery looked different.

The familiar railroad and platform. Why didn't I notice it before?

「Staging.」

It wasn't a real staging, but it seemed like he had activated a kind of 「Simple Staging」 by paying for probability.

"You seem to have forgotten who you were, Youngest."

In that moment, I realized how he had activated [Time of Judgment].

"Ha."

The creativity of the Demon King of Salvation was truly unimaginable.

The insight that replaced the conditions of agreement of the absolute good constellations with the power of 「Staging」.

The [Time of Judgment] that the Demon King of Salvation had just activated was not something from this world, but something borrowed from a 'different world line'.

All the events of this simple stage 'already happened' in some world line.

"Geumho."

I smiled bitterly as I looked at the familiar writing on the platform.

The Demon King of Salvation asked with a grin.

"You said you would become Kim Dokja who would never die, right?"

This was the station where 'Cheon Inho' was born, and the station where my scenario began.

「The Judge of Evil. The strongest judge among the three great judges, just woke up in Geumho.」

But this 'Geumho Station' is not the 41st Round, but the 1,864th Round. It is the very place where Jung Heewon, who was the 'crouching figure', awakened as the 'Judge of Evil'.

The 'villain' Cheon Inho of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' dies here from the sword of 'Judge of Evil' Jung Heewon.

"See if you can survive, Youngest."

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[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 787 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (3)

My heart was beating wildly.

I'm dying. I'm really dying here.

I could see my death on the coming day.

The very scene where Jung Heewon killed Cheon Inho. The incident that shocked everyone at Geumho Station was about to be reenacted before my eyes.

「It's because Jung Heewon pierced Cheon Inho's face from the crown down.」

And there was the Demon King of Salvation looking at me from the other side of the incident.

[The Constellations of <Olympus> are absorbed into the stage!]

[The Constellations of <Vedas> are absorbed into the stage!]

[The Constellations of <Asgard> are absorbed into the stage!]

The directing ability of the story that even made the enemy Constellations absorbed.

I was purely amazed by that ability and nodded.

I know that he doesn’t want to kill me either. But he has to act that way anyway. That’s the scenario. This is a game where only one Kim Dokja can survive.

「That fact made my heart beat.」

I swung my 'Unbreakable Faith' to block the rushing sword. However, even though I activated [Time of Judgement] by using [Incite], [Sentence Strengthening], and [Bookmark], I could not stop the flow of the stage.

Blood burst from the corner of my mouth, and shallow sword wounds remained on my waist and shoulder.

「This is the power of history that Kim Dokja survived with all his might.」

The sword strikes of the Demon King of Salvation became faster and faster, and I continued to be pushed back.

At that moment, the Demon King of Salvation's sword pierced through my gap.

I thought that I really couldn't avoid it this time.

"Kim Dokja!"

Someone pushed me, and a small explosion occurred in the air.

"What are you doing? Come to your senses."

At first glance, it was a tone that could be mistaken for Yoo Joonghyuk's. But that won't happen anymore. Because I know who he is.

"Let's join forces!"

The Second Apostle, Killer King had finally arrived here. And that wasn't all.

"We're here. Friend."

Lee Dansu, who had appeared leading a large number of low-level loyal servants, charged the army of bugs toward the Demon King of Salvation.

"I'm here too! Ughhhhhhh! I'm scared to death!"

Kyung Sein, who had used [Average Correction] to increase her stamina to the limit, clashed with the Demon King of Salvation.

The moment the Demon King of Salvation's body was pushed back by the reckless charge, a splendid sword light flashed in the sky.

「Baekcheong-ganggi, who was much more skilled than me, was embroidering the air and restraining the Demon King of Salvation.」

"Go, Yerin!"

LiteraryGirl64, Cha Yerin, spun around in the air and fell down like a top. The combined attack of Killer King and Cha Yerin, the ultimate command of [Main Battle Action Mode] had been activated.

Kwakwakwakwakwa! A blow that could shatter Lee Hyunsung's steel-like armor.

Even so, the Demon King of Salvation did not fall. He simply silently swung his sword and blocked Cha Yerin's attack.

Cha Yerin's body was thrown toward the group with a huge shockwave.

"He's strong."

Cha Yerin's hand, which had collided with the Demon King of Salvation, was swollen red.

"He's unbelievably strong."

"Because he's Kim Dokja."

I told Cha Yerin that.

"And we're Kim Dokja too."

With these people, we can fight no matter how far behind we are. Although we haven't lived as long and distant a history as the Demon King of Salvation, we've done our best to get here.

「The 41st world line is our world.」

The stories we've shared together began to stir and boil together.

The Demon King of Salvation also seemed to know that fact, so he lightly flicked his fingers into the air.

['High-level Demons' Appear!]

'High-level Demons' rose up simultaneously in the water.

"Be careful!"

As the high-level demons surrounded the forest in an instant, the group centered around Killer King stood guard.

"Formation A. Everyone gather!"

"There's no such thing!"

"Kim Dokja! Come to your senses! We'll take care of these guys!"

The sound of people being hit and broken was heard here and there. Kyung Sein's screams and Dansu's credit. Killer King's energy mixed together to form a mess.

I couldn't help but feel ashamed of the thought of salvation.

"You're really a brilliant leader."

That's right. We've lived through such a chaotic history. We've endured life by following the actions of the characters and reenacting the stories we liked. That's how we got here.

"You can't kill me with stories like that."

The combined attack of the high-level demons would have been difficult to deal with in the past. Nevertheless, the group held on well. They held on.

"Yes. It's a mess all the time, so I'd like a story where no one dies."

The eyes of the Demon King of Salvation wavered at my answer. I didn't miss that moment and rushed toward him.

A sword strike flew from the air once more.

"You know how that story ends, right?"

"Yes."

"Are you still going to continue that story?"

"Yes."

I nodded firmly and said.

"That's our story, isn't it?"

The Demon King of Salvation's blade shook subtly.

I made another bold move.

[The story 'Tenacious Martial Arts Master' begins its storytelling!]

I pushed my sword without stopping.

A story received from Arc of the Dragon Head Cheongae.

All the stories I had learned and mastered were embedded in my blade.

"Do you remember? When we first met. You gave me a lot of advice back then."

Even now, when I close my eyes, a clear voice comes to mind.

—What kind of characteristic is the circulatory delay?

—[Incite] Why can’t you use it like that?

—Do you know any other stories besides 「Persistent Martial Arts Master」?

—And that’s not all the skillsyou’ve gotten. Why don’t you use [Nagak Breathing]? Do you practice Skill Linking?

These were the homework assignments left to me after the Demon King of Salvation disappeared.

While I was staying at the Recycling Center, I practiced stories and skills day and night. I knew that my proficiency wouldn’t increase enough with just this short period of practice, but I didn’t rest.

Just like the day I first started writing a novel, just like that time when I wrote and erased countless sentences, I trained all the possibilities I had.

[The proficiency of the exclusive trait 'Circulation Delay' has achieved great success!]

[The exclusive trait 'Circulation Delay' is linked to the exclusive skill 'Nakgak Breathing'.]

With one breath, the magical power swelled like wildfire. The 'Circulation Delay' characteristic was linked to [Nakgak Breathing].

The long breath I sucked in circulated the magical power of my entire body, making it possible to link incredible skills.

[Baekcheong-ganggi and 「The Tenacious Martial Arts Master」.]

The mutually contradictory martial arts and stories harmonized, and the ether blade rose from my swordplay.

I swung my sword while holding my breath. I swung my sword again and again until my breath ran out. Blood spurted onto my cheeks and the broken stories scattered. My breath reached the tip of my chin.

The Demon King of Salvation was looking at me in such a desperate manner.

「You've improved a lot, Youngest.」

I continued to swing my sword while hiding my pent-up emotions.

We are the sponsor and the incarnation.

「It's still not enough.」

「Yes, it's still not enough.」

A Constellation and a human who share each other's inner feelings without saying a word.

「I can become stronger.」

「I have to become stronger.」

「So please teach me.」

The moment the flow of 'Circulation Delay' and 'Nagak Breathing' ended, the weapon of the Demon King of Salvation, who had been pushing forward, changed. The form of 'Thought' had changed into the 'Ground Rat Sword'.

The weapon that Jung HeeWon used when she killed Cheon Inho in the 1,864th Round.

[The effect of 'Simple Stage' has increased!]

The Demon King of Salvation was saying.

In order to change this story, I have to change it myself.

I have to destroy the history he has built up from the past head-on.

"I—"

I opened my mouth with all my might as I watched Jung Heewon's sword flying towards me to finish Cheon Inho.

"I am not Cheon Inho!"

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' is activated!]

A spark fell from the air, and the Demon King of Salvation's sword was twisted.

[The reproducibility of 'Simple Stage' is reduced!]

The blow that would have definitely killed me missed.

It was because the stage effect was weakened due to [Incite].

But even with that [Incite], the stage effect could not be dispelled.

The Demon King of Salvation shook his head and worked.

"It's amazing, you can now use [Incite] well, but…"

He already had the power to resist my [Incite].

Well, if I had been able to [Incite] the Demon King of Salvation in the first place, I wouldn't have been pushed back in this fight.

I thought it would have been better if I had just a little more time.

If only I had time to examine each and every one of the legends I had accumulated.

But I didn't have time, and the Demon King of Salvation's blade was too close. A squeak, and weakness came over me. The incarnation body that had been pushing itself hard since absorbing Goo Seonah had finally reached its limit.

I acknowledged it. What kind of ability did I have now? Even if I exert myself, I cannot beat the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

He is my sponsor. What I can do, he can do too.

He is the first Kim Dokja of this world.

The Elder Brother of all Kim Dokjas, and the Constellation that introduced me to 'Kim Dokja'.

"The match is not over yet. Don't look at me with those eyes."

"Youngest."

The eyes of the approaching Demon King of Salvation were shaking. The fear that I might really die.

I looked at that fear straight in the eye and laughed.

"I told you. I will become the first Kim Dokja who will never die. Because—"

I knew from the beginning that I could not defeat him. He had been a Narrative-grade Constellation for a long time, and I was just an incarnation that could now act as his representative.

So I waited.

I bought time until someone who could truly defeat him appeared.

"I absolutely do not intend to be the main character."

The sword of the Demon King of Salvation that had been rushing towards me was deflected. The power that could block the attack of that powerful Narrative-grade Constellation. While the surprised Demon King of Salvation widened his eyes, a man in a fluttering black coat gave an order.

"Lee Hyunsung! Lee Jihye! Shin Yoosung! Kim Namwoon!"

The four people who received the order jumped out from the bushes. The combined attack of the four people seemed to be pushing back the forces of the upper-level demons little by little.

「There was Yoo Joonghyuk, who held the Wolgeuk.」

It was just the appearance of the main character, but it felt like the sentences that had been chaotically scattered were finding their places. I sighed involuntarily. I realized

once again whose 'story' this world was.

In an instant, Yoo Joonghyuk cleaned up the surroundings and stood next to me and said.

"It's pathetic."

As I looked ahead with a bitter smile, the Demon King of Salvation was also facing me.

The Demon King of Salvation standing alone without any companions. His one starlight seemed a little lonely at that moment.

"Is that so?"

Starlight seemed to be counting down the years, and also seemed to be reminiscing about the old story in the scenario that had now become worn out.

"That guy was the Yoo Joonghyuk you discovered."

I couldn't even imagine the feelings of the Demon King of Salvation. All I could do was nod.

The Demon King of Salvation smiled faintly. That smile was all we could share at the moment.

"You really intend to kill me."

As expected, he knew all about my plan. In order to counter the 「Staging」 on the other side, we had to use 「Staging」 on this side as well.

We had to recreate the only stage in this universe where we could kill the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Both he and I knew very well what that 'stage' was.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its storytelling.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 788 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (4)

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The story, 「Demon King of Salvation」.

Since it was the core story that put Kim Dokja as a Constellation, it was very difficult to recreate.

[The conditions for 'Staging' are partially met.]

Before we knew it, the 'High-level Demons' had been sorted out, and Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, and Shin Yoosung had gathered around us.

Just then, Ji Eunyu appeared through the bushes. Jung Heewon was carried on her back.

With this, most of the members of <Kim Dokja Company>, including Lee Gilyoung, who had fallen, had gathered.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who represented them, glared at the Demon King of Salvation from afar and muttered.

"Is that guy a 'Great Demon'?"

"Yes."

"What kind of evil scheme are you plotting again?"

"An evil scheme? This is a clear operation."

Since this was the 'Recycling Center' and the scenario was 'hunting the Demon King of Salvation', the probability itself needed for 'staging' was sufficient.

The Demon King of Salvation kept nodding his head as if he had figured out all of my plans.

"This will be fun."

I bit my lips without realizing it.

Can you even say that at this moment?

For him who looked as excited as a child, I must now write the last sentence he wants.

The Demon King of Salvation said, spreading his arms wide as if he would take on the role of the villain.

"Okay, let's begin."

The stage opened with a rippling background.

Lee Jihye, Lee Hyunsung, Shin Yoosung, and Kim Namwoon surrounded the Demon King of Salvation on all sides, and then Killer King, Cha Yerin, Lee Dansu, and Kyung Sein joined in.

"Hit!"

With Lee Jihye's shout, a sharp light swept over the Demon King of Salvation's entire body. Between the dust that rose up in a thick haze, Lee Hyunsung and Kyung Sein continued to butt-fight.

The Demon King of Salvation raised both hands and caught the two.

"The group was running."

While the Demon King of Salvation’s hands were tied, Cha Yerin, who activated [Main Battle Action Fighting], and Kim Namwoon, who activated [Knife Fighting], aimed behind the Demon King of Salvation.

「In the <Star Stream>, existence is 'stories'.」

[Baekcheong-ganggi and Heukhwa combined attack.]

The Black and White Energy stabbed the Demon King of Salvation in the back.

「In the gaze of countless Constellations pouring down from the sky, the story that would kill him was approaching one sentence at a time.」

It felt strange. This was the story that had once killed him.

I remembered the <Kim Dokja Company> of that time. None of them really wanted to kill Kim Dokja.

How is it now?

"Yup! It's empty!"

Lee Jihye, Lee Hyunsung, and Kim Namwoon were swinging their weapons at Kim Dokja without any hesitation.

The only ones who showed lukewarm movements were Shin Yoosung and readers like me. Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu looked back at me several times and asked with their eyes.

"Are you okay?"

They knew who the Demon King of Salvation was and why he was there.

They knew what he had sacrificed to protect this universe. Nevertheless, I nodded at them.

That was the only way I could change this story.

"Master!"

The last attack was from Yoo Joonghyuk. The Wolgeuk in his hand surged forward, scattering pitch-black energy. The golden energy in the changgeuk hit the Demon King of Salvation's stomach.

Kim Namwoon grumbled.

"Did you hurt him?"

The Demon King of Salvation's incarnation was revealed through the smoky dust. Despite the combined attack of the group, the Demon King of Salvation was barely injured. Kim Namwoon muttered in shock.

"What kind of a bullshit—"

"Master, is that really something you can beat?"

[The '73rd Demon King' enters a new phase!]

At the same time as Lee Jihye grumbled, a message was heard from the air.

[The Great Demon King, the 'Demon King of Salvation' rises in rank!]

"Crazy. They're saying he's getting stronger there?"

The Demon King of Salvation's body fired magical blades in rapid succession. He was leisurely taking on the entire group while building a barrier with [Way of the Wind].

"Youngest, this story doesn't make me 'weak'. You haven't forgotten, have you?"

I remembered it too.

During the 73rd Demon King scenario, he survived attacks from the entire <Kim Dokja Company>.

An entity that neither Han Sooyoung's [Avatar], Jung Heewon's [Hellfire], nor Shin Yoosung's Chimera Dragon could eat. He was the scenario boss, the Demon King of Salvation.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

However, regardless of whether the opponent was a Demon King or a Constellation, the influence of「Staging」was absolute.

"Take it!"

Yoo Joonghyuk caught the 'Cheonjongun Sword' that I had thrown. He seemed to have figured out why I had thrown the sword at that moment.

"Is it a guy with the resurrection trait?"

Then the Demon King of Salvation answered on my behalf.

"That's right. I will be resurrected even if I die."

"This sword can erase the resurrection trait."

"That's right."

The Demon King of Salvation nodded as if he agreed and then playfully grinned.

"But I don't know if you can do it."

Instead of answering, Yoo Joonghyuk swung the Cheonjongun Sword.

「The power gained through the story is ultimately destroyed by the story. His resurrection trait, 'Eight Lives', comes from the power of the Constellation Yamata no Orochi.」

The trajectory of [Breaking The Sky Swordsmanship] was recorded on the blade of the Cheonheungun Sword. The moment the final touch, which even erased the resurrection trait, reached the chest of the Demon King of Salvation, his lips trembled slightly.

[The realization of 'Staging' shakes.]

Yoo Joonghyuk's surprised sword seemed to shake, and then the Demon King of Salvation waved his hands and struck the sword away.

It was unbelievable.

The power of 「Staging」 was absolute. No matter how strong the Demon King of Salvation was, there was no way he could take the Cheonjongun Sword.

I staggered toward the battlefield. Yoo Joonghyuk stepped back and stopped me.

"Don't come. You'll die if you keep that state."

"What did he just say?"

I saw it clearly.

The Demon King of Salvation said something to Yoo Joonghyuk, and from then on, Yoo Joonghyuk's condition changed. Yoo Joonghyuk thought for a moment and then confessed in a small growl.

"He said I wouldn't be able to use this sword properly."

He can't use that sword?

I wondered what that meant, but a message immediately came to mind.

[The current target is suffering from the side effects of 'Binding of Truth'.]

Binding of Truth.

One of Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Story Engravings', where some of his memories are sealed in exchange for gaining great power.

I suddenly raised my head and asked.

"Have you forgotten how to use the sword?"

"I can't use it like before."

Is that so?

Yoo Joonghyuk's main weapon in the 41st Round was the 'spear'. So he must have sacrificed 'how to use the sword' as a sacrifice for the Story Engraving.

The Demon King of Salvation looked at me from afar and grumbled.

"Do you understand now?"

I answered calmly.

"I expected it."

"Really? Then you know the solution."

Is it because I was tired? My consciousness kept fading. For a brief moment, my consciousness flickered and flickered.

Right now, it seemed like 'that' would be possible.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Think about me from now on."

"What nonsense are you talking about—"

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me with a serious expression. Then, the skill was activated.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is activated!]

The moment my incarnation body fell, my soul was inhabited by Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation through [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

Yoo Joonghyuk, surprised, said.

"You, how—"

'There's no time to explain in detail now! Give me the sword!'

The phase of the Demon King of Salvation passed once again.

Now, the party was being pushed back in a hurry instead of pushing forward. Every time the Demon King of Salvation made a light gesture, a huge shock wave occurred, pressuring the party.

Yoo Joonghyuk shook his head and said.

"In my current state, I can't use this sword properly. It would be better to hold a spear—"

'No, this time, take the sword. And that too!'

Yoo Joonghyuk picked up the two blades that had fallen next to my incarnation body —'Ray Bringer's' 'Light Wish'.

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader Viewpoint' activates to the limit!]

[Exclusive skill 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World' activates!]

Then, the text of 'Ways of Survival' began to appear.

「In the darkness, Yoo Joonghyuk held the sword.」

In accordance with the flow of the text, Yoo Joonghyuk also held the sword again.

「In the time fault of the dark dimension, Yoo Joonghyuk swung the sword again and again.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had undergone extreme training to become a transcendent. The record of Yoo Joonghyuk was being passed on to Yoo Joonghyuk through me once again. As if he had noticed what was happening, the corners of the mouth of the Demon King of Salvation's mouth widened into a smile.

"That's amazing."

This was a strategy that Kim Dokja had once used. 'Reviving the forgotten tale of Yoo Joonghyuk through the 'Ways of Survival'.

"You've grown up a lot, Youngest."

The swords clashed.

A cracking sound that tore through the sky.

The two swords repeatedly aimed for each other's neck, chest, and shoulder. The thighs were torn and the shoulders were split. Blood spurted onto the ground.

Even so, the swords did not stop.

This was not enough.

The Demon King of Salvation probably also knew that I would use the 'Ways of Survival'.

I couldn't defeat him with the 'story' he already knew.

That's why,

「A story that the Demon King of Salvation doesn't know.」

I had to rewrite this story, a story that I had once left unfinished.

Calmly drawing an old scene in my head. It was the story of the prison guard who ruled over infinite time.

「Ma Hyunsung looked at the Demon King of Salvation.」

I could see a look of surprise and bewilderment on the Demon King of Salvation's face.

「Upon closer inspection, it seemed like him and the Demon King of Salvation somehow resembled each other. No, maybe he resembled the Demon. After a long fight, they had finally become a part of each other.」

'Yoo Joonghyuk!'

「I know that the story won’t end here with the defeat of the Demon. I also know that I will be lonely after the end of a long fight. When even the one great enemy who understands him—the Demon—disappears, his world will be filled with emptiness.」

'Ray Bringer' and 'Light Wish' emitted bright light and soon transformed into a single sword.

Sacred sword.

Light Bringer.

The decisive weapon of the protagonist of 'Infinite Instructor', Ma Hyunsung, and the only weapon that can effectively strike the Demon.

「Even so, he decided to walk toward that emptiness.」

The sacred sword Light Bringer emitted light along with a bright ray of light.

「He decided to cut down his only understanding and confirm the end of this forest where nothing exists.」

One of the Demon King's arms gave birth to empty space. His fluttering coat was torn and the sound of his bones breaking was heard. The Demon King was in a hurry and 'Thought' seemed to be changing to 'Unbreakable Faith'.

However, it was a mistake.

[The reproducibility of the stage is increased!]

If the 'Ground Rat Sword' increased the reproducibility of the Geumho Station stage, 'Unbreakable Faith' contributed to the reproducibility of the stage of 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"Ah."

Yoo Joonghyuk's right hand moved as if by magic. A single sword traversed the light beam revealed by Light Bringer. A devastating blow that shattered the sky where Constellations hung was placed at the tip of Cheonheungun Sword.

With the sound of the stomach skin being pierced, the expanding magic wave swept through the center of the battlefield like a storm.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> are calling out to you!]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Vedas> are suspicious of your activities!]

[Some Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are attempting to invade the Recycling Center!]

[All Constellations of the 'Recycling Center' are staring at the battlefield!]

…

[You have achieved a non-existent achievement!]

[All the Dokkaebi of the Management Bureau are astonished at your story!]

…

[Exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is released!]

I woke up with a spurt of blood. I gasped for breath several times in my messy incarnation body and got up from my seat.

I started to walk unsteadily.

"Please."

That's when someone grabbed my hand.

"Don't kill him."

With the voices dispersing, the hand that had been holding me disappeared. I could not feel any signs.

I wondered if it might have been Lee Gilyoung.

I looked at the spot where Lee Gilyoung had disappeared for a moment, then staggered forward again.

The group had collapsed where the pitch-black dust had settled. Lee Jihye, Lee Hyunsung, Kim Namwoon, Shin Yoosung...

And someone was sitting on their knees in the center of the dust storm.

I called his name.

"Kim Dokja."

He didn't answer. I called him again.

"Demon King of Salvation."

Then he raised his head. My older brother was there, smiling with blood dripping from his mouth and his stomach pierced by the Cheonchongun sword.

[The Great Demon King, the 'Demon King of Salvation' meets his fate.]

The old prophecy of the stellar nebula was once again coming true.

「The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' will die in the story he loved.」

He smiled as he faced that fate.

Is this really the story you wanted? Can you even say that you love this kind of story?

[Your sponsor completely transfers his status to you.]

A Constellation that hung in the infinitely high sky. A Constellation that protected me in that sky over and over again. Now, that Constellation was within arm's reach.

I slowly knelt before him.

"What a pity."

Like someone who had finally graduated from this story, the Demon King of Salvation was smiling dazzlingly.

"I want to read it one more time."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 789 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (5)

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I quietly looked at the Demon King of Salvation. He and the starlight that had been so dazzling were now dimming.

The reason was simple.

[Your current existence restoration rate is 10%.]

The amount of 'Kim Dokja fragments' that I possessed had increased more than that.

I quietly held my brother's shoulder that had shrunk.

You can read it again.

---

The Demon King of Salvation opened his eyes.

It seemed like he had woken up from sleep, or like he had died and come back to life. To him who was used to death, perhaps the two were not so different.

He exhaled lightly, and felt a pleasant chill. He looked around.

All he could see was a plain covered in pure white snow. The Demon King of Salvation sighed lightly in that solemn landscape.

Just by looking at the fluttering white snow, he could tell what kind of place this world was.

This is the Youngest's world.

He thought about the Youngest.

The last Kim Dokja in this world. A being born with a different mission than other readers.

The Youngest has always lived seeing this scenery.

The Demon King of Salvation stretched out his hand toward the fluttering snow. Then, a faint whisper could be heard through the snow.

「"King King! King King!"」

The cries of ground rats searching for their mothers.

「"Save me! Save me!"」

The cries of those who died after failing to overcome the first scenario.

「"If only there was one more chance, one more chance..."」

The last wish of those who died after being crushed under the rubble of a collapsed building or eaten by monsters.

Some were recorded and some were not. They all fell asleep between the lines. The Demon King of Salvation shook the snow in the air again while waiting for someone to read it, to imagine it. This time, different stories were heard.

「"Let's die together even if we die! Don't give up!"」

It was the story of the people of Geumho Station fighting back to back to save each other.

Bang Cheolsoo, who had become a different person than in the previous round. And the sight of the mother and daughter fighting beside him.

「"Come on, let's have a bite!"」

Homeless people at Seoul Station sitting in a huddle in front of the remaining open signboard, sharing warm soup.

「"I wonder if that hyung is doing well."」

Jung Heewon's younger brother—Jung Eunho and the children of the Beggar Sect were also there. The children, who no longer needed to set traps and deceive the adults, chatted around the campfire.

Countless Constellations hung in the sky that the children looked up at.

[The Constellation 'The Last Ark' watches over the descendants of the Beggar Sect.]

An old tower was floating in a corner of the shining sky.

'Recycling Center', Zone 13.

「"Shouldn't we go help too?"」

Animals that couldn't enter the <Zodiac Ball> were gathered in a small inn in Zone 13.

「"But will we be of any help..."」

「"If it weren't for that friend, we would have been forgotten."」

「"What do you think, Master Crane?"」

The sentences that remained like faint footprints. The Demon King of Salvation carefully read the sentences that were open but definitely present. He read them diligently, as if he were afraid that there would be a sentence he hadn't read.

How much had he read like that?

Someone was standing in front of him.

"Is it fun?"

It was the Youngest.

The Youngest looked much more like 'Kim Dokja' than before.

Looking at him like that, the Demon King of Salvation didn't know what to say. Since he didn't know what to say, he had a set plan for what to say.

"What's next?"

"Of course there is."

The two sat side by side and read the stories. They read happy stories, sad stories. Or they read stories that couldn't be defined as happy or sad.

They just liked the story.

"Is there more?"

"There's still a lot left."

He knows. That the Youngest had prepared a lot of stories for him. But now he didn’t have much time left.

He heard a sound like waves crashing. He raised his head and saw the distant edge of the snowy field slowly breaking apart.

The waves of destruction were coming.

"Youngest."

"Yes."

"I read hard."

"I know."

"Even though I read so hard—"

The end of his voice broke into small pieces like the waves that were coming.

The Demon King of Salvation smiled bitterly.

For what, for whom had he kept 'reading'?

"Reading alone couldn’t change anything."

Life is life and death is death.

No matter how many times he read it—no matter how much effort he put into it—the world didn’t change.

Someday, the universe will end.

This story will definitely end.

Even though every tragedy is predetermined, even though they know that fact well, why do they read it?

"At least I've come to understand one person better."

"One person. Perhaps that one person is a different name to each and every Kim Dokja. There are also people who have come to understand you better while reading your story."

"…"

"Can you really say that it means nothing?"

The Demon King of Salvation had no answer to the Youngest's question.

"I've thought about a lot of things since I came here."

The Youngest let out a small breath and began to talk.

"When I first fell into this world, I thought I was really screwed. Wow, how am I going to survive? How am I going to get back?"

"That was fun."

"You were watching everything, after all?"

"Hmm."

"Anyway, after somehow surviving, I then had this question. Isn't there a reason why I fell into this world? This world must have called me because I had a mission given to me!"

"…"

"That's why I worked hard to dig around here and there. I converted villains who hadn't been in the spotlight, communicated with monsters who had been rampant, and investigated the backstory of scenarios that weren't shown in the main story—"

"It was a mess."

"Yes. In the end, I asked you for help because I couldn't do it alone."

"In a pitiful state."

"But thanks to you, I have many interesting stories."

Interesting stories.

The Youngest called all those failures, those bitter memories.

"That’s why I’m going to keep going."

Hearing that calm voice, the Demon King of Salvation recalled the expression on the Youngest’s face when he first called him.

"Please keep reading. I’ll keep writing too."

The Youngest was still speaking in that same voice.

"I’ll prove that the world can change just by reading."

Looking at the Youngest’s shining eyes, the Demon King of Salvation thought.

「If I could be reborn, I hope I’m not Kim Dokja.」

Every Kim Dokja has their own theme. The Youngest in front of him right now was no different.

「I hope I’m not 'Dokja'.」

The reason why the Youngest was so special among all his brothers. That was—

"Youngest."

"Yes."

"Don't you have something to ask me?"

"…"

"Aren't you curious about who you really are?"

The Youngest quivered and sighed.

"Of course I'm curious. But honestly, right now, I'm not sure what to do."

"What?"

"Right now, my head is full of things I want to write, so I don't have time to think about who I am."

"…"

"Someday, my hyung will read and tell me who I was."

The Demon King of Salvation blankly stared at the Youngest.

Wouldn't it be okay if it was this guy?

Wouldn't it be okay to entrust the future of all readers to this guy?

The Demon King of Salvation slowly stood up from his seat while watching the waves of destruction approaching.

"Okay, I will."

"Thank you."

"In that sense."

The Youngest also stood up.

The Demon King of Salvation spoke to the Youngest.

"Now you are the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

The time had come.

It was time to tell all his stories to the Youngest. The Youngest would receive all his stories and become the 'only Kim Dokja'.

"Huh? I don't want to."

"What?"

"How many times do I have to die and resurrect and do that?"

The Demon King of Salvation opened his mouth.

The Youngest continued to talk.

"I can't live like that. Oh, man, I'd go crazy."

"No, hey."

He wanted to tell him that being stubborn like that wouldn't work. He wanted to tell him to come to his senses, that he shouldn't be saying things like that anymore.

But the Youngest's eyes were strange.

"I told you. I'm going to write an 'impossible story', and you won't die in that story."

The snowfield was breaking.

The Youngest continued talking, looking at the waves that were now right in front of him.

"Why did you think about it for so long? If I really am Kim Dokja— wouldn't I be able to do 'that' too?"

He felt something was wrong. The Demon King of Salvation urgently reached out his hand to the Youngest.

"Youngest. Wait a minute—"

"Don't worry, you can just keep reading there."

The waves soon came crashing down on them. The world was shuffled around, and the Demon King of Salvation felt his soul being sucked away somewhere.

As expected.

He would become a story. He would become part of the 「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」.

The Youngest would read him and live in this world once again—

「("Huh?")」

He should have disappeared and become part of the Youngest, absorbed.

But why? Why does his ego still remain?

The light flickered between the bookshelves.

The smell of old books in the dark space.

It was a small library.

He knew this place well. He knew it well, so he got goosebumps. His heart pounded hard.

「("Who else is here?")」

He turned his head and saw the little Kim Dokjas gathered together in a huddle.

There were girls and boys. The little Kim Dokjas with different hairstyles. The little Kim Dokjas, who were looking at him with curious eyes, all raised their heads like a seagull at the sound coming from behind them.

「("Ah. Newspaper.")」

「("Read it quickly.")」

The little Kim Dokjas were gathered in front of the desk, reading something. He staggered toward it. There was a newspaper on the wide desk.

『Today's Kim Dokja』.

A newspaper without a headline.

He read the newspaper, mixing in with the little Kim Dokjas. Sentences appeared on the newspaper in real time.

「A method to absorb 'Kim Dokja fragments' while protecting their souls.」

It was the Youngest's sentence.

「Like 'Asmodeus's Cinema, can't I use the same method?」

The noise rose once again.

Had he prepared this space since he was 2?

「Will I be able to use the [Fourth Wall] if I become a Kim Dokja of 2 percent?」

「If I were to create that 'library'—」

The Youngest, who didn't want to be just a reader, said. If he were to write an impossible story, then the Youngest,

「Wouldn't it be possible to dream a new 'dream'?」

He might have already written that first sentence.

A library that would make the impossible story he spoke of possible.

A space where Kim Dokja's reading could continue

[Exclusive skill 'The Fourth Wall' is activated!]

But from there, a slightly strange sentence began to be written.

「The Constellation, Successor To Salvation, prepared for the death that would come.」

The moment he wondered what that meant, a message came into his head.

[The 'Fate' that bound you is no longer functioning.]

He was brought into the [Fourth Wall] by the Youngest, and lost his qualification as the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

And so he is still 'alive'.

So who is now taking on the fate of the 'Demon King of Salvation'? A creepy imagination flashed through his mind.

Youngest.

Pitch-black letters were being written on the margins of the newspaper.

「The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' will die in the story he loved.」

Somewhere, the sound of destiny being realized was heard.

[You are no longer the 'Demon King of Salvation.']

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 790 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (6)

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I spat out the bloody lump that had come out, grumbling, onto the floor.

[Your incarnation body has reached its limit!]

That's it. This is how I achieved my goal.

The fact that I was able to hold on even when I would have fainted if I had been normal was proof of that.

[Exclusive skill 'The Fourth Wall' is activating!]

The fact that this wall has activated means that the readers I've absorbed, and my sponsor, have safely entered the 'library'.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' glares at you with displeasure.]

I smiled bitterly and answered the story, who was grumbling.

'Thank you.'

If that little story hadn't cooperated, it would have been impossible to restore the [Fourth Wall].

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' turns his head while snorting.]

[Your current existence restoration rate is 18.8%.]

The existence restoration rate has increased to almost 20%. In fact, I felt that my soul's level had increased significantly compared to before.

[Nebula <Asgard> recognizes your existence as a threat!]

[Nebula <Vedas> designates you as a singularity!]

Now, my level has increased to the point where I cannot avoid the attention of the Constellations. This was even though I was still unable to properly control the Constellation within me.

[The story 'King of a Kingless World' is running wild!]

[The story 'One Who Stands Against the Fate' is out of your control!]

I have inherited all of the abilities of my brother, the Demon King of Salvation, so perhaps that is only natural.

I tried to calm the stories down and took a deep breath.

[Story Fragment 'Unrequited Love' is shaking unsteadily!]

[Story Fragment 'Young Man Who Speaks Like an Old Man' is shaking!]

[Story Fragment 'The Heart of a Child' is running wild beyond your control!]

Story Fragments that are still awkward to call my own.

Among them, there were Goo Seonah's, Kim Kyungsik's, and even an unknown reader's.

Some of the stories had such severe side effects that they were impossible to absorb, especially Goo Seonah's story.

It was at that time that [Incite] ran wild and spread out recklessly, touching <Olympus>'s 「Hermes System」.

Thanks to that, I was able to annihilate all the great Constellations in <Olympus> that had invaded the Recycling Center, so it may have been a good result.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> show their hatred towards you!]

I guess this means there is no turning back for <Olympus>.

Well, it doesn't matter. They were going to kill me anyway.

"Dokja-ssi!"

As I listened to the voices of the group running towards me, I barely managed to hold on to my consciousness that was about to break away.

[Main Scenario #20 — 'Graduation' has ended.]

The scenario was definitely over. However, not everything was over yet.

Just as my future path was more important than graduation, what was going to happen from now on was more important to me.

[You have inherited the modifier of 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

[The <Star Stream> recognizes you as the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

[The role of 'Great Demon King' is inherited!]

[The delayed Fate is activated.]

[You succeeded the scenario.]

[You failed the scenario.]

At the same time, it was clear what it meant.

I as an incarnation succeeded in the scenario, but I as a Constellation failed in the scenario.

Why—

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' accepts Fate.]

Right now, I have become the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"What the—"

The moment Kyung Sein, whose eyes had become sharp, reached out her hand toward me, I jumped up enormously.

"Uh, uh?"

My energy began to rise into the air.

"Dokja-ssi, why—"

Kyung Sein looked up at my stomach with his eyes wide open.

"Why Dokja-ssi, the Cheonjong-un Sword….."

Cheonjong-un Sword was piercing me instead of the incarnation of the Great Demon King of Salvation.

"This is the price of reciting the story of 'Salvation's Learning'."

"Isn't the scenario over?"

Kyung Sein and Dansu ahjussi were flustered.

I looked down at the two of them and smiled.

The people who survived until now, I am grateful to them. Now, they have become incarnations that can do one person's work. Even if I am not here, they will somehow survive. They will be able to get through the next scenario, and the one after that.

"Yes. It's all over."

I felt my body slowly being sucked back. The crack that had formed in the air was sucking my body.

「Where does the Demon King who lost to the scenario go?」

If I had been bound to the scenario like my sponsor, I would have died here.

However, I was not dedicated to the scenario, I just received his [Fate].

So even if I was pierced by the Cheonjong-un Sword, I wouldn't die here.

"Dokja-ssi!"

"No! Dokja-ssi! Stop!"

I would just be banished to a place where there was a very high chance of death.

I waved my hand to calm the group down and said.

"Don't worry! I won't die! This is just—"

"Do you think we're stupid?"

Killer King, who had shouted, grabbed my arm through the aftershock.

"You, what the hell did you do? Why is the scenario banishing you!"

It seemed that I couldn't fool the readers.

"Everyone, catch him! Don't let him go!"

It was the first time I saw Killer King so passionate .

I looked at him and said.

"Cha Sungwoo-ssi."

Cha Sungwoo looked at me in surprise.

I realized that many things had happened since meeting him. However, we had talked a lot, but not that much.

We don't know much about each other.

Where we used to live, what kind of food we like to eat, what games we like to play, what we think about before going to bed after a hard day.

We don't know anything about each other.

The only thing we share is one thing. That we've read the same stories and admired the same characters.

"Come to your senses. You're the Yoo Joonghyuk of those people."

Cha Sungwoo trembled as if he had been struck by lightning after hearing my words.

A person who has the patience to read a story a hundred times. A person with an unwavering spirit that won't waver in the face of any ordeal.

The group needs such a pillar.

"Shut up! Kim Dokja, what do you know—"

With a crack, my sleeve that he was holding onto was torn. The crack sucked me in even more strongly. At that moment, when I was about to be swallowed by the crack, a spider web flying from the air tightly tied my body.

「Arachne's Web.」

It was Ji Eunyu.

At the same time, the group holding each thread of the spider web began to pull me.

"Pull! Quickly!"

I saw the group hanging on the spider web and pulling me.

Cha Sungwoo, Cha Yerin, Kyung Sein, Lee Dansu, and Ji Eunyu.

Shin Yoosung pulling together behind Ji Eunyu. Lee Jihye and Lee Hyunsung, who joined in late. Kim Namwoon pulling the rope with one hand as if he was going to die.

And where the words fell, there was Jung Heewon, who was just beginning to shed tears. It seemed that walking was still difficult, as Jung Heewon staggered and reached out her hand toward me.

I looked at her like that, then looked back at the things and laughed heartily.

"Come on, everyone, don't worry. I won't die. I promise!"

That's why I didn't want to be 'The Demon King of Salvation'.

"Don't make promises like that! If you say something like that here, you'll—"

I knew how deep and distant the 'salvation' in his modifier was.

Even so, I received that modifier, and unfortunately, the group had now become the companions of the Demon King of Salvation.

The spiderwebs that had slowly grown began to break one by one. Just like the stories we had tied together were coming apart.

"No!"

Ji Eunyu's extended spiderweb broke.

I spoke to Ji Eunyu, who was moving away.

—Ji Eunyu. You always said that.

I really have no intention of dying.

Since I had no intention of dying, this parting had to be refreshing.

—Excessive emotions actually hinder the readers' immersion.

I heard Ji Eunyu shouting something from afar, but I couldn't hear it.

[You have been banished from the scenario!]

Pitch-black darkness covered me. A place where I could see no stars.

A terrible cold air then came. It was a cold that was hard to bear, even with the [Fourth Wall].

[The tory 'King of a Kingless World' resists the cold!]

[The story 'One Who Stands Against Fate' resists the cold!]

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' resists the cold!]

The sharp cold began to dig into the stories that surrounded me. I felt the stories that formed the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' freezing in real time.

「The movements of the stories are slowing down.」

It was clear what was happening.

「The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' will die in the story he loved.」

This was the end that the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' would face. And after I, as a Constellation, perished, my weakened incarnation body would also begin to disappear.

At that moment, a voice was heard along with a faint warmth.

—You.

I knew whose voice it was, so I smiled and answered.

'Bihyung.'

—Damn bastard.

「Dokkaebi Communication. Even that was about to break off, and the voice of the form that came in was unstable.」

I simply stated my business.

'Can I receive the item I requested to purchase earlier?'

As the original author of 『Infinite Instructor』, I was able to receive a huge amount of coin royalties while working on the scenario as the original author.

I used more than half of the coins I had acquired to buy one item.

—This… is an item that cannot be sold, you know?

'It is.'

—You will not survive if you buy this.

Bihyung must know. I will die now with a very high probability.

As a Constellation, and as an incarnation.

'Please go. If you stay here too long, you will be suspected.'

—Survive somehow, you idiot…!

Bihyung's voice broke off.

A cold air came over me again.

[The story 'King of a Kingless World' stops talking.]

Every time a story lost its function, it felt like every joint in my body was being torn apart. I checked the item that Bihyung had given me with my pale, frozen hands.

It was a small horn.

'Horn of the Horizon.'

An item that sends the user to the 'Story Horizon'.

I took a few deep breaths and blew my remaining breath into the horn with all my might.

[Using the item 'Horn of the Horizon'!]

Soon, with the sound of a small whistle, my body began to fall somewhere. I fell, fell, fell again, and how long did it take? When I came to my senses, I was on the cold dirt floor.

I suddenly raised my upper body from the floor.

A garbage dump was visible through the blurry sky.

My stomach churned and I felt like crying.

I survived. I somehow made it here.

「Story Horizon.」

I don't know. I will definitely survive and return to my companions. And so, I abandon Kim Dokja's story.

The moment I looked up at the sky with that thought, the sky, which should have been empty, flashed. Several flashes of lightning struck the ground, and something descended on the ground. <Olympus> Constellations.

[That's it, young Demon King. No one can protect you anymore.]

I smiled bitterly.

"This is it."

I never thought those bastards would chase me to a place that wasn't even a scenario area —to be exact, this landfill.

"You must be really angry."

I squeezed out the last of my strength and started my story. Then, my heart stopped.

[The story 'One Who Opposes Fate' stops talking.]

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' stops talking.]

[All the stories of the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' stop talking.]

I felt the strength drain from my entire body and fell forward. Finally, the stories of the 'Demon King of Salvation' had finished their mission.

[Your destiny is realized!]

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' loses his qualifications as a Constellation!]

[The Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation'’s modifier disappears from the Constellation!]

A coldness different from before pierced my skin.

I could see the Constellations laughing at me and approaching me step by step.

They really are vicious. I would die even if they left me alone, but they came all the way here to finish me off.

In the gloomy sky, I could see letters floating around them.

It was a story I knew well.

I understood many things later. The reason why they were able to maintain a healthy castle gate while invading the lower scenarios so recklessly.

「They had already collected a considerable amount of 'Kim Dokja Fragments.'」

And just like Asmodeus, they had figured out how to use them in some way.

A faint sense of despair came over me. I thought that this time, there was nothing I could do. If I had known this would happen, I would have just given my stories to Ji Eunyu or Killer King.

But I couldn’t give up until the end. The moment I thought about somehow activating [Incite]—

"■■. ■■■ ■■■…!"

I heard someone chattering. I raised my head and saw a familiar new figure. A man in a pitch-black coat and holding a long spear was glaring at me.

Yoo Joonghyuk?

For a moment, I couldn’t understand.

How could Yoo Joonghyuk be here?

He should have cleared the scenario by now and returned to Earth, so why—

[The subject is currently performing a 'personal scenario'.]

Personal scenario. A scenario that the Constellation can specially grant to incarnations who clear scenarios after number 10.

If someone had granted Yoo Joonghyuk a personal scenario, it wasn’t impossible for him to appear. But who on earth would take such a risk right now?

There could be no crazy Constellation that would chase me all the way to the Scenario Exile Zone and give Yoo Joonghyuk a 'personal scenario' against the will of the Constellations—

"Is that the way to live good? You ■birds■."

Wait a minute. Did Yoo Joonghyuk… swear like that?

I could see white wings fluttering behind Yoo Joonghyuk.

A sigh escaped belatedly.

There was one. One person.

A Constellation that spit out harsh curses with a face more beautiful than any Constellation I know.

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' does not wish for your death.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 791 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (7)

"I've never lent you my mouth, Archangel."

At Yoo Joonghyuk's irritating words, the Archangel's wings fluttered gloomily.

Soon, with the sound of parts, a translucent figure like a butterfly that had just shed its skin from Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation emerged.

[The Constellation 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' appears in an area outside the scenarios!]

It was the descent of a 'Narrative-grade Constellation'.

Archangel Uriel.

The Constellation that gave up all of its stories to protect Kim Dokja.

Warm emerald eyes turned to me.

[I'm sorry. Did you wait long?]

When I heard that voice, I suddenly felt like tears were about to fall.

[It's okay now. I'll protect you.]

Her incarnation body, which had descended halfway, was shaking unsteadily.

She was not a being from this world line, but Uriel from the 1,864th round. Perhaps she made a contract with the 'Uriel' of this world through some kind of covenant, and thus descended here now.

"Uriel..."

Perhaps the Kim Dokja she wanted to protect was not me. The Kim Dokja she remembers is not in this world. Perhaps he is not anywhere in the universe.

Even so, she came here to protect Kim Dokja.

I felt the legacy of the old Kim Dokja in front of that noble determination.

But even with her arrival, things were not easy.

[An Archangel protecting the Demon King, how interesting.]

[Do you think you can stop us alone?]

The 12 seats of <Olympus> were before my eyes.

[The Constellation 'Pure Moonlight Hunter' reveals her status!]

[The Constellation 'Almighty Sun' reveals his status!]

Pure Moonlight Hunter 'Artemis' and Almighty Sun 'Apollo'.

Two of the 12 seats came here.

Just to catch me. No, maybe it wasn't two.

[Uriel, get out of the way.]

The third Constellation of the Narrative-grade that appeared with a chilling blast of air.

[The Constellation 'Spokesperson of Justice and Wisdom' reveals her status!]

The Spokesperson of Justice and Wisdom, Athena.

Uriel frowned, not knowing that she would come too.

[You don't like it? And don't speak informally. I'm not the 'Uriel' you know?]

Only then did Athena notice something and her expression changed.

[You're not—]

[Oh. Right. It's annoying to explain, so if you noticed, get out quickly.]

[Archangel of another world line. Why are you interfering with us?]

[Because you're doing bad things.]

Bad things. Uriel glanced in my direction as she said that.

[Since when did the 'Spokesperson of Justice and Wisdom' become a villain who persecutes the weak.]

[He's not weak. He is the Demon King, and this world—]

[Objections and penalties., do you think that boring logic you have is still working? Do you really think that kid is 'evil'?]

Athena couldn't answer.

[Even that kid is not even a Constellation or a Demon King anymore. Because of that damned fate you've called, he's now a mere incarnation that can't resist anything. And yet you're going to kill that kid?]

Athena bit her lips and glared at Uriel.

[Are you really going to fight here?]

[Then what are you going to do?]

[Do you know what will happen if <Eden> and <Olympus> go to war?]

[■Eat it. My <Eden> has already been destroyed.]

Athena's eyes looked like she was wondering what she meant, but she soon seemed to have made up her mind and took out her holy relic, 'Aegis'.

[Artemis. Apollo.]

At Athena's signal, the three of the twelve divine seats surrounded Uriel.

Uriel glanced at them and spoke to Yoo Joonghyuk.

[Do you remember what I asked you to do?]

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

[No matter what happens, you must protect him.]

At the same time, Uriel and the three divine seats disappeared.

Following that, a radiance that covered the pitch-black universe burst out. As the red flames poured out by the omnipotent sun Apollo illuminated the universe, Artemis' arrow flew in, leaving a blue trail.

Uriel was also holding a holy relic in her hand.

A sword containing the most sublime flame of [Hellfire].

'Flame of Karma.'

As the Archangel's sword split the universe, the sun's corona and the hunter's arrow split apart at once.

A fighting power that was on par with the 12 gods of <Olympus>.

The 'Flame of Karma' was not only pressuring the three gods, but also slowly pushing them back.

It was truly astonishing power.

No matter how much Uriel was the Archangel of <Eden>, she was not able to fully use the power of the 1,864th Round.

Even a half-body, not an incarnation.

And yet, that's all.

Artemis, whose face turned blue, shouted as if she thought that this couldn't go on.

[Athena, danger—!]

Uriel flew.

As the pure white wings spread out and rippled, leaving a deep shadow in the universe, Uriel's sword, which had cut off countless demon kings' heads, moved.

[Everyone, fall back!]

Athena raised Aegis at the signal. Aegis' immortal defense wall spread out while scattering.

[What the—]

That 'immortal defense wall' was slowly melting away. Soon, the flames of [Hellfire] that completely tore through the outer shell of the defense wall were about to pour down on the heads of the three gods.

"Get out!"

Yoo Joonghyuk shouted.

A pitch-black wave came in silently.

Uriel was swept away by the wave in an instant. Then came the roar of the monsters. The sound of something being torn apart.

The wave disappeared, and Uriel was staring at the direction the wave had come from with a large wound on her shoulder.

Then, as if responding to that gaze, the wave answered.

[Foolish Archangel. Do you know what you are up against?]

My heart felt like it was going to burst just from hearing the voice. Sparks exploded fiercely all over the place. As if not caring about such probability, the giant body of the god was swaying in the void.

Just witnessing their true form was enough to take my breath away.

Only after Yoo Joonghyuk, standing next to me, unleashed his status, did I barely manage to catch my breath and stare ahead. There was a mythical Constellation of <Olympus> there.

「Where his spear touches, it will soon become the sea.」

<Olympus>'s third god. The Spear That Draws the Boundary of the Sea—Poseidon.

Uriel smiled bitterly.

[Oh, the rumor has already spread that far?]

Instead of answering, Poseidon grabbed his beloved Troiana. The waves of the deep sea surged like an active volcano through Troiana's spear.

I staggered up like a crazy person.

"Uriel. No. Uriel—"

Even if it's Uriel, she can't face them all.

I have to stop her.

If this continues, Uriel will die, but my voice didn't come out properly.

I grabbed Yoo Joonghyuk's wrist. Please save Uriel.

But Yoo Joonghyuk spoke in a blunt voice.

"The scenario I received is to protect you."

I wanted to swear at him. But my exhausted body did not listen.

A distant wave crashed down on Uriel. It was a tidal wave that she, exhausted, could not handle alone.

Thump.

That was when the sound of gunfire was heard from somewhere.

Thump.

One shot, two shots, three shots. The continuous barrage of fire directly hit the waves that were coming. It broke, broke again, and the momentum of the tidal wave began to weaken little by little.

Goosebumps ran down my spine.

I couldn't figure out what was going on.

"You're doing well. Be sure to keep that promise, Master."

I knew who that voice belonged to.

Lee Jihye.

As expected, she was someone who shouldn't be here, someone who couldn't be.

Yoo Joonghyuk also looked at Lee Jihye with surprised eyes. He couldn't help it. The 'power' flowing out of Lee Jihye's body right now was clearly higher than Yoo Joonghyuk's own.

"Ahjussi."

The moment I heard the voice directed at me, I knew right away.

Where did 'Lee Jihye' come from?

"I can only help you for a little while. This 'covenant' is really short."

A covenant from another world.

She came here even after making that difficult contract.

"Thank you for saving Gilyoung."

"Gilyoung—"

"Don’t worry. He’s safe."

Thankfully, Gilyoung seemed to have returned safely to <Kim Dokja Company>.

"My dongsaeng got beaten up in a faraway place, so I can’t just sit still as a noona."

My heart kept pounding even though I knew I shouldn’t.

<Kim Dokja Company> was here.

They came not to stop us, but to save us.

Lee Jihye looked at me with calm eyes before turning back to Yoo Joonghyuk and saying.

"Master, I’ll say this once. Run away with all your might, taking ahjussi with you."

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned. The expression on his face was that he didn’t like the fact that he had to 'run away' as the expression said.

But Lee Ji-hye ignored that expression and said.

"You know that if you lose ahjussi, it’s all over, right?"

"…"

"I don’t know how this world will end, but if ahjussi falls to that side, it’s definitely the worst ending. So I have to protect him."

"Even if you don’t say anything—"

"If by any chance ahjussi dies…"

Lee Jihye took out the 'Twin Dragons Sword' she had on her waist and added coldly.

"Master, you'll die to me."

Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth as if he was dumbfounded.

Well, where on earth would Yoo Joonghyuk hear such words from Lee Jihye?

But that Lee Jihye had the right to say such things.

She was Lee Jihye of the 1,864th Round.

She was a member of <Kim Dokja Company>, an incarnation of Admiral Yi Sunsin, and the successor of the Breaking the Sky Swordsman who broke the sky after Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The Constellation 'Maritime War God' proudly helps its incarnation.]

When on earth did they appear?

There were Constellations watching over this world where there wasn't even a scenario.

[The Constellation 'Bald General of Justice' cheers on the Maritime War God.]

[The Constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' admires the Maritime War God's spirit.]

[The Constellation 'Maegeumjijon' praises the Maritime War God's courage.]

They were Constellations.

[Currently, a 'temporary channel' is in operation.]

It seems that Bihyung opened a temporary channel for me.

Poseidon, who responded to their indirect messages, took a step forward.

[Silent! This is not a place for the Constellations of such low ranks to interfere.]

With Poseidon's gesture, waves began to surge from all directions. Top-tier marine species poked their heads out between the waves. Fangs that looked as if they would tear Lee Jihye apart at any moment.

Lee Jihye swung her sword toward the teeth of the waves.

Breaking the Sky Sword.

Breaking the Sky Ryu Seong-gyeol.

The sword light that flashed from the Ssangryong Sword pierced all the marine species in the waves.

Poseidon's eyes widened in shock, and the deep-sea waves that had been engulfing him suddenly stopped.

As if to show respect to another master of the sea.

The Constellations of the 1,864th Round called her this.

「The monarch of the great sea.」

The sound of crashing waves was heard.

Across the pitch-black space, the sea three, the bows of the ships began to rise one by one behind Lee Jihye's back.

"I heard that our master had a showdown with Odin."

She stood at the front of the lined-up fleet and looked down at the sea god of Olympus with proud eyes.

"If it's you, I'll be able to get some relief."

As the enraged Poseidon swung Traiana, the tidal wave surged again.

The woman standing in front of the tidal wave raised her twin dragon swords. [The Ghost Fleet] moved.

「The monarch of the sea is not defeated at sea.」

Lee Jihye opened her mouth as if to prove that sentence.

"Load the cannon."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 792 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (8)

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Lee Jihye signaled.

"Fire!"

Lee Jihye's ship began to fire.

Poseidon frowned as he was hit by the concentrated fire. He swung Triana with all his might, as if he could not accept the fact that he was tied down by a mere human's fire.

[Get out.]

The blue created by the light of the snow swept across the surface and hit the ghost fleet directly. The ships could not withstand Poseidon's attack and sank.

[Skill, reactivate 'Ghost Fleet Lv.???'!]

However, the ships were revived by Lee Jihye's simple signal. The fleet, which was in perfect condition with not a single bit of damage, began to fire again.

"Load! Fire!"

This was the reason why she could reign as an invincible monarch in the ocean. As long as there was an ocean, her fleet could never be destroyed. Poseidon growled as if he

didn’t understand, kicking away the barrage.

[The sea is mine! If you don’t clean up that trash right now—]

"You’re talking just like the old man."

[What?]

"Why is the sea yours? Did you buy it with money?"

Who would dare to make such a fuss in front of a Mythical Constellation?

Poseidon, who had frozen for a moment, answered in a distorted voice.

[The gods of our <Olympus> created the sea. And I am the great—]

"That’s nonsense. The sea existed before you were even created. Didn't you learn about primordial soup in school?"

In fact, Lee Jihye doesn’t know much about how the sea was created either. She wasn't listening in science class.

However, while they were killing time with pointless conversation, there were two people running through the hazy sea of space.

The 41st master. And—

'The 41st ahjussi.'

Lee Jihye knows that he is not the Kim Dokja she remembers. But now, that didn't matter.

No matter what world Kim Dokja was in, Kim Dokja was Kim Dokja.

Lee Jihye accepted that fact.

「Ahjussi chose this world.」

She didn't know why. However, Kim Dokja judged that there was an ending that could only be reached by reading this world completely.

Lee Jihye respected that judgment and decided to reserve her judgment.

She didn't know whether Kim Dokja would return to them or not. This world might be a comedy or a tragedy. However, just as Kim Dokja once protected her, she would protect

Kim Dokja's choice.

And at the end of this world, she would grab Kim Dokja's neck, who was laughing stupidly, and say, "I knew this would happen."

'For that to be possible.'

First, she had to take down Poseidon in front of her.

「The Mythical Constellation, Poseidon.」

A great star that she wouldn't have dared look at in the past. Even the king of the underworld, 'Father of the Rich Night,' had a hard time with it.

'But if it were me now.'

The tension between the two beings across the sea began to rise endlessly.

As Lee Jihye's momentum grew fiercer, Poseidon's expression hardened even more.

"Mr. Sea. I'm going to give it my all from now on. Can you handle it?"

Even if it's a Mythical grade Constellation, it's burdensome to explode above a certain level.

This is a universe without a 'scenario'.

If one made a mistake, one could draw the attention of the gods of the other world.

In other words, the fight here was a matter of life and death even for a Mythical grade Constellation.

[Young human, who do you think I am?]

The sea grew angry. As the storm raged, waves swirled around and began to distort all the ships.

A strong gale that even the Constellations wandering nearby were swept away.

[Get out of here!]

Artemis and Apollo retreated in fear. It was a disaster that even a Mythical-grade Constellation would not be able to survive if it was swept away. Only Lee Jihye ran

through the storm of disaster. Her [Ghost Walk], which had been developed to its limit, assisted her steps, and her [Kendo], which had reached the realm of transcendence, paved the way. [God killing]'s eyes flashed in the foam covering her head.

Poseidon's new form was visible in the distance.

Looking at the shadow that seemed close enough to touch but not quite there, Lee Jihye thought of the old Kim Dokja's face.

「"Jihye-ya."」

She always felt like an outsider in this story.

She was not as strong as Yoo Joonghyuk, as smart as Han Sooyoung, or as affectionate as Yoo Sangah.

「"Well, so what?"」

She was also not as honest as Jung Heewon, as firm as Lee Hyunsung, or as desperate as Shin Yoosung.

Even after seeing the end of the world, breaking through the [Fourth Wall], crossing world lines, and finally losing Kim Dokja— she was still an outsider in the story.

「"You worked hard. I know."」

「Instant Kill reached the limit and cut through the waves. The waves that jumped up left cuts on her cheeks and arms like blades, but she didn't stop.」

She cut and cut again. How many times did she cut?

"Ahhhhh!"

A blind wave cut through her side. Bright red blood spurted out and she was swept away by the current. The storm of a mythical Constellation was ravaging her entire body. She could see the sea creatures that smelled blood coming towards her.

She didn't put down her sword even as she was being pushed here and there.

"I really liked your story."

That day, the 'Lee Jihye' that Kim Dokja had talked about was not her. So she tried. She swung her sword again and again to become the Lee Jihye that Kim Dok-ja had talked

about. In order to reach the sentence that Kim Dokja had read, in the end, she hoped that that damned ahjussi would read her alive here someday.

「Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.」

A phrase that was barely obtained after training and training again.

「True God Ouijeolgi.」

There is no such technique in Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.

If the master or the great master Breaking the Sky Swordsman had seen it, it would have been greatly criticized, a technique that does not even appear in the 'Ways of Survival'.

「Breaking the Sky Myeol Hwanggeom.」

The swordsmanship that was only possible through Lee Jihye's swordplay shone.

「A tragic attack to destroy the king of a world.」

She doesn't know if Kim Dokja is seeing this.

But if he was, she really wanted to tell him.

Kwaaaaaaaaaa—

The exploding sea screamed, and Poseidon's incarnation body leaped out.

The moment Poseidon, whose side was deeply torn, let out a loud scream, Lee Jihye's sword cut Poseidon.

Through the flying water droplets, the scenery of the 'Recycling Center' could be seen in the distance. Looking at the school scene that was being torn apart by the storm, Lee Jihye, who had spat out a lump of blood, laughed bitterly.

'You must come to the next graduation ceremony.'

---

「The story was pouring out of Kim Dokja's heart.」

Sentences that appeared in real time above the newspaper.

「Yoo Joonghyuk ran while blocking the story from flowing out.」

If this continues, the youngest will die.

The Demon King of Salvation scolded the kkoma Kim Dokjas around him to calm his troubled mind.

「"Hey, don't you have any other solutions?"」

The kkoma Kim Dokjas looked at the Demon King of Salvation all at once. It seemed as if they were asking himwhy he was asking that.

「"Wasn't that person the biggest Kim Dokja?"」

「"He's a pitiful hyung."」

When the Demon King of Salvation suddenly opened his mouth in shock after being bombarded, the kkoma Kim Dokja with his hair tied in a ponytail spoke.

「"You said you were the first Kim Dokja."」

As the Demon King of Salvation nodded, Ponytail Kim Dokja asked again.

「"Then there's a 'Second' too, right?"」

「"That's it."」

「"I don't know what the circumstances are, but right now doesn't seem like the time to be weighing the pros and cons."」

The Demon King of Salvation twitched his lips and let out a light sigh.

The kkoma Kim Dokja was right. The most important thing right now was the survival of the youngest. For that, the 'Demon King of Salvation' would do anything.

He slowly took a deep breath and opened his mouth in a loud voice.

「"Second. Can you hear me?"」

The 'Second Kim Dokja' is not here.

But even if he's not here, he'll be listening.

「"I know you're upset about my decision. You probably wanted to stay with <Kim Dokja Company>."」

If he can't hear, [The Fourth Wall] will tell him instead. That guy has this skill too.

「"It's all my fault. I'll admit it. So just this once—"」

With his eyes tightly shut, the Demon King of Salvation thought about the 'Second Kim Dokja'.

「"Just this once, can't you help the Youngest?"」

He is Kim Dokja who understands the deepest sadness of anyone in this world.

「"If this continues, another sad story like you will be born."」

And after a while, sentences began to appear on the newspaper again.

---

Yoo Joonghyuk ran with me through the darkness. The universe was pitch black, and I couldn't see anything. We ran through that universe together. To be exact, Yoo Junghyuk ran alone, with me by his side.

I squeezed out the voice that was barely coming out.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

"Don't say anything. The stories are leaking."

Yoo Joonghyuk took the angel out of his arms and bandaged my wounds. He used the secret of martial arts, Cheonjangsa, on me. Honestly, I was touched.

"You are a good guy after all. My eyes were not wrong."

As if asking what nonsense I was talking about again, Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me with sharp eyes then put his arm around me. Occasionally, an explosion could be heard from afar.

What happened to Lee Jihye?

Even if it were Lee Jihye, would she be able to defeat Poseidon?

Even if Poseidon was defeated, it wouldn’t be the end. <Olympus> had many powerful gods. Zeus, who was in the upper row, was there, and there were the other 12 gods.

<Olympus> wasn’t all that there was.

And there weren’t just one of them chasing us now.

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Vedas> are looking for you!]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are looking for you!]

[The Constellations of the Nebula <Gwiok> are looking for you!]

…

The story of the 'Demon King of Salvation' had exhausted its power, and I was no longer a Constellation or a Constellation’s agent. I was just an incarnation with a few plausible stories. Now, all I could do with my weak incarnation body that couldn’t even make a sound was to use an item to convey my intentions.

[You have applied for the 'Midday Tryst'!]

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned for a moment and nodded hesitantly.

['Midday Tryst' connected.]

Anyway, you’ll accept anyway, so don’t be annoyed.

—Just leave me alone and go.

I could feel the presence of Constellations chasing us from afar. Even Yoo Joonghyuk couldn’t possibly deal with them all. It would be impossible even if he used all of the story imprints.

—I know you received a personal scenario. But even if that fails, there’s no particular penalty, right?

Yoo Joonghyuk’s personal scenario was established by Uriel’s authority.

There was no way Uriel would suggest a scenario with such an excessive penalty to Yoo Joonghyuk.

—I’m going to die soon anyway.

Of course, I really didn’t intend to die. There is a way to survive.

There must be.

But it would be difficult if Yoo Joonghyuk is by my side. If Yoo Joonghyuk is here, Yoo Joonghyuk will also be in danger.

—Why are you trying to save me?

That's why I made up my mind.

—Aren't I a nuisance to you anyway? You've disliked me from the beginning.

No matter what happens, let's get this guy away.

—I'm not the Cheon Inho you were looking for. I'm not the one who deceived the stars, nor am I a great villain who can subdue the Ten Evils. I…

"I know."

—What do you know? Of all the Yoo Joonghyuks I know, you know the least. I…

"You're not Cheon Inho. I know."

Yoo Joonghyuk cut me off and looked at me.

"You're Kim Dokja."

Kim Dokja.

"I don't know if that's your real name or not, but I'll call you that for now."

The way Yoo Joonghyuk called that name in the 41st Round felt strange. I said with a bitter smile.

—Yes. Please do. And that Kim Dokja, just put him down and run away. That's what you have to do.

"My job is to save you."

—No, why?

The sound of crows could be heard nearby. It seemed that Odin's 'night crows' had come nearby.

Now there really was no time.

But Yoo Joonghyuk continued speaking in a calm voice.

"You saved both the mainstream and weak groups of people at Geumho Station."

—Yes.

"It was stupid. In the end, turning people who would otherwise be divided into one group is meaningless and pointless."

I wanted to refute him right away, but Yoo Joonghyuk continued speaking.

"You did strange things at Chungmuro Group, too."

I recalled what had happened at Chungmuro Station.

"You blocked the 'emergency defense' that I had set off. It was worthless. All the people at Chungmuro Station are destined to become subordinates of the Ten Evils."

—No, wait. What on earth are you trying to say…

"When we elected the station representative, I clearly gave you the flag. But you dared to refuse to be the 'representative'. Because of that, everything went awry."

—That's…

"Even at the Washington Dome, you did something you shouldn't have done."

Yoo Joonghyuk continued to talk as if he didn't want to hear my answer.

The point was that I only did things I shouldn't have done.

"All those things ultimately led to your death."

Is that what he wanted to say?

I nodded with a bitter smile.

—Yes. That's right. It was a poor choice.

But Yoo Joonghyuk didn't finish talking.

"Why did you save me?"

—Yes?

"I tried to kill you several times. At Geumho Station, at Chungmuro Station, and in the theater dungeon. But why did you—"

Come to think of it, I saved Yoo Joonghyuk quite a few times in this round. In the theater dungeon, in the Washington Dome.

It just so happened that way.

—You always saved someone, didn't you? Isn't the opposite also possible sometimes?

Yoo Joonghyuk licked his lips several times and then opened his mouth.

"You won't be able to reach the end of the scenario with such a naive story."

I couldn't figure out what this Regressor was trying to say.

Is he trying to criticize me since I'm about to die?

At that moment, I saw my story flowing out through the tightly tied ceiling.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at the story without saying anything.

It was only then that I realized what this damned regressor was trying to say.

「How does Yoo Joonghyuk know everything that happened to me?」

I thought maybe no one would read it. No one would remember how I lived and what stories I had built up.

"And yet that pathetic story—"

But there was someone who had read the whole story.

"It was the first time I'd seen it."

He was the main character of this world.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 793 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (9)

There was silence for a long time. The one who finally broke the silence was Yoo Joonghyuk.

"What are you laughing at?"

—Just that.

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me as if he were looking at a strange person.

Actually, it wasn’t a situation to laugh at.

「The 'Night Raven' legion under Odin who rules the skies of <Asgard>.」

From a distance, I could see the crows charging their magic power and preparing their magic cannons. If they started firing, we would be turned into a beehive in an instant.

Still, I thought it was okay.

「"It was the first time I ever saw such a pathetic story."」

With those words, I felt acknowledged. That the way I had lived was not wrong, that all that time had been meaningful enough.

—You said that you couldn’t go back anymore.

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

—Is that still true?

Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at the sky and answered.

"Maybe."

—You’re not going to run away, are you?

Yoo Joonghyuk agreed with silence.

After all, Yoo Joonghyuk is Yoo Joonghyuk, whether he regresses or not.

In that case, I should also play the role of Kim Dokja.

—Okay. Let’s fight.

As if he was saying, "What nonsense are you talking about?" Yoo Joonghyuk’s hand held me with strength.

"If we fight head-on, you—"

—They can’t kill me.

It wasn’t just Odin’s 'Night Ravens' that were approaching.

Enemies were swarming from all sides.

The Constellations of <Vedas>. And the pursuers from <Olympus> who were aboard the 'Argo'.

The vast net spread by the Constellations in each region surrounded us without a single gap.

—Because I’m needed.

Now, I’ve become one of the 'largest fragments of Kim Dokja' that exist in this world line.

So from now on, those guys will fight over me.

—Throw me when I give you the signal. You have to throw me exactly in the direction I instructed.

Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to understand what I was saying right away.

"It might not work out the way you think."

—Isn't the <Star Stream> something that doesn't work out the way you think no matter what you do?

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned and muttered.

"Damn it."

—Now!

Yoo Joonghyuk threw me at the signal. I quickly crossed the space and headed to the exact midpoint between <Vedas> and <Olympus>.

[This is a joke! Capture him!]

The heroes of Greek mythology aboard the ship 'Argo' surrounded me. At a glance, they were all great Constellations.

Orpheus, Theseus, Castor, and even King Oedipus, who had nothing to do with the ship.

Kukukukukuku!

That was when a thunderous roar echoed through the void.

[What—]

King Oedipus looked around and screamed in shock. At the same time, the 'Argo' collided with something.

I witnessed the wondrous sight of a huge ship and a train colliding in a huge explosion.

[The Supreme God of Light!]

The ship's crew shouted and rushed to Surya's sun chariot.

The brightly shining Surya released his own energy in response.

[The Constellation 'Supreme God of Light' reveals his status.]

One of the 'Locapala' of <Vedas>.

'Supreme God of Light' Surya.

The Narrative-grade Constellation of <Veda> that appeared in the main story's Demon King Selection Tournament was revealing its power.

[Kuaaaaak!]

The Historical-grade Constellations that could not handle Surya's light melted away with screams.

The great Constellation, as if it had no interest in the small-timers, turned around and looked at me.

[Are you 'Kim Dokja'?]

I felt really strange. I never thought I would meet Surya like this.

I answered with my voice barely recovered.

"But."

I briefly hoped that this Surya might also be from the 1,864th round like Uriel, but it didn't seem to be the case.

He looked down at me with a curious gaze and said.

[If you follow me obediently, I won't harm you.]

"How polite of you."

Instead of answering, Surya summoned a giant palm from the air. The palm made of stories grabbed my entire body.

I frowned and asked.

"A Constellation like you wouldn't move easily. Is this an order from <Vedas>?"

[I have no obligation to answer.]

"Aren't you against the will of <Vedas>? Why do you continue to be the henchman of the Nebula?"

At my words, Surya's eyebrows furrowed.

[What is your intention in making such a fuss?]

"Do you know? The person I knew really pulled an amazing train."

Surya, the 'Last Engineer' who led the train of <Kim Dokja Company>. If he hadn't been there, the characters in the main story wouldn't have been able to overcome the final wall.

"Shall I show you a little?"

I recalled the sentences I had written in detail. Then, the sentences immediately came to mind as story fragments.

「Surya's entire body, sitting in the engine room of the train, was dazzling like the incandescent sun.」

Surya's eyes widened as he touched the story fragments.

「Without showing any sign of it, he ran the [sun chariot] using his own body as fuel. As if it was his mission as the 'god of supreme light' who had lived all this time.」

Surya's grip loosened. It was only for a moment, but it was enough of an opening for me.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had approached me in an instant with my signal, caught me.

Surya screamed.

The [Fake News], which had reached its limit, crossed the scenario change. It barely managed to break through the encirclement, but it wasn't over yet. The train's engine start sound was heard again from afar, and the Constellations chasing us continued to scream.

"We can't run away like this forever."

—It's okay.

I said, keeping an eye on the Constellations chasing us.

—Because 'those things' will soon be coming.

This place is not a 'simple scenario outskirts'.

This is the border of the Void Curtain and the outskirts of <Star Stream>.

In other words, it was a place where the boundary with the 'other world' was blurred.

Tsk tsk tsk!

Sparks resonated everywhere as if they had been waiting. Portals began to open one by one in the aftershock.

What appeared beyond the portal were pitch-black hunting dogs.

「Hounds chasing the abyss.」

The hounds of the other world that protect the rules of the <Star Stream> have appeared.

[The dogs are coming!]

The Constellations' convulsive cries.

The night ravens of Odin that were wandering nearby had their wings torn off by the hounds' teeth, and the Constellations screamed.

Constellations exploding everywhere and hounds trampled by trains.

In the shaking vision, the Nebulae and foreign news chasing us were mixed together to form a huge hellscape.

「It seemed as if the entire universe was chasing us.」

I and Yoo Joonghyuk were in that hellscape.

Maybe it was because the situation was so unrealistic. I laughed heartily and then lost consciousness several times and woke up repeatedly.

[There is currently no scenario assigned to you!]

[Your incarnation body is in danger!]

My body trembled several times as if I had been shocked. For a moment, my consciousness went black and I was in a snowy landscape.

「Kim Dokja.」

I called out that name without realizing it. Then, along with the cool air, I saw someone's shadow.

A coat fluttering lightly in the wind.

I instinctively reached out my hand toward him.

Who is that Kim Dokja?

Is it the Demon King of Salvation? The 49% Kim Dokja? Or is it another Kim Dokja I haven't met yet?

The moment I thought about that, I realized that his coat wasn't white.

The eerie Demon King's wings stretched out from behind the red coat.

It wasn't Kim Dokja.

「Are you still looking for that name?」

A familiar face looked back at me.

It was a face I knew well.

「Cheon Inho.」

I got goosebumps. Cheon Inho had never appeared in the snowfield before. Nevertheless, the being before my eyes was definitely Cheon Inho.

He slowly lowered his body and looked at me.

「You've really become a different face now.」

A voice suddenly came to mind.

【Do you really want to know? Even if that truth could ruin you forever?】

A voice I once heard in my fading consciousness.

I was sure of it.

It was definitely Cheon Inho’s voice.

Cheon Inho nodded as if answering my question.

「You've really reached the end of the 'Recycling Center'. That's great. Now you know who you are.」

Who am I?

I clearly came here because I was curious about that question.

So did I know the answer?

「Save Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Cheon Inho smiled with his eyes, perhaps finding my request amusing.

「That little bastard hates me.」

「If I die here, you die too, you son of a bitch.」

My current body is Cheon Inho's. So if I die, Cheon Inho's body will be destroyed as well.

「I won't die. Above all, aren't you now 'Kim Dokja' instead of 'Cheon Inho'?」

「I'm not going to play with words.」

「You still don't know who you are?」

「I—」

I recalled the memory I had seen through Goo Seonah at the Recycling Center.

The confrontation between Kim Dokja and Kim Dokja.

The 49% Kim Dokja who was trying to protect the 41st world line, and the Demon King of Salvation who was fighting against him.

I hesitated and asked.

「Am I… the 49% Kim Dokja?」

Cheon Inho looked at me for a moment and then asked back.

「What on earth does '49% Kim Dokja' mean?」

「What?」

「There must be a Kim Dokja who has 49% of the memory called A, and there must be a Kim Dokja who has 49% of the memory called B. Then can we say that the 49% of those two are the same 49%?」

I was speechless for a moment.

Cheon Inho was talking right now. The concept of total memory content is meaningless when proving a human being.

Cheon Inho nodded his head as if satisfied with my appearance.

「I think you finally found the answer.」

「I—」

「Kim Dokja who didn't want to remain Kim Dokja.」

Cheon Inho's sharp eyes were asking me.

「Do you want to save Yoo Joonghyuk?」

I nodded.

「Then do what you can do best.」

What I can do best.

「That's why you came to this world. Didn't you want to change the ending of this world?」

Cheon Inho opened his eyes and a vast snowy landscape was captured in his eyes.

「Write it yourself. With your dreams, try to convince the rest of the world.」

With a gasp, I regained consciousness. My vision was intermittently shaking. The screams of the boiling Constellations.

I was still riding on Yoo Joonghyuk's back. How long had I been asleep? It seemed like my incarnation body had recovered a little more than before. Did I take an elixir while I was sleeping? Or,

[The exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is being strongly activated!]

Is it because of the [Fourth Wall]?

"You're awake."

Yoo Joonghyuk's tired voice.

Yoo Joonghyuk's condition was confirmed.

The moment I did, my heart skipped a beat.

Arms and legs torn off by hunting dogs. His entire body covered in blood. Yoo Joonghyuk limped forward in that state.

"How much time has passed?"

"Three days."

I swallowed my breath.

Yoo Joonghyuk had been running away from the Nebulae and Outer Gods for three whole days, carrying me while I was unconscious.

"Why—"

He could have easily run away on his own. If he had been alone, there would have been a way to survive. But Yoo Joonghyuk didn't run away.

I heard the sound of blood and the sound of Yoo Joonghyuk's knees giving out. Yoo Joonghyuk, looking down at his protruding kneecap, slowly put me down on the ground and fell forward.

"…Run away."

As I watched him mutter like that, I took out a summoning squad from my chest. It was an elixir I had prepared in advance for times like this.

I poured the crushed elixir into Yoo Joonghyuk's mouth. Even while his consciousness was in disarray, Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me.

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is strongly activated!]

I slowly closed my eyes.

There were eyes watching us from beyond the wall.

My sponsor. And the readers whose names and faces I don't know, but who were once 'Kim Dokja'.

I thought of them.

"Thank you, Yoo Joonghyuk. You've done enough."

Just as they are Kim Dokja, I am also Kim Dokja.

And any Kim Dokja would have no choice but to make the same choice as me at this point.

"No matter what happens, you must survive."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who glared at those words, miraculously got up.

He activated [Recovery].

But I didn't give him a chance and released my status.

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk, who lost sight of me due to the temporary shock, moved away, I shouted into the air.

"Demon-like Judge of Fire!"

At my call, a bright star twinkled in the distant universe.

"Uriel! Please return Yoo Joonghyuk to Earth right now!"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 794 Episode 37 Graduation ceremony (10)

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With a squeak, something bit my sleeve.

It was Odin's night crow.

The crow, with its ominous cry, asked mockingly.

「Have you given up?」

I smiled and answered.

"No."

「There is no Constellation that can help you now.」

I know that too.

What Constellation could help us, who have become enemies of the entire universe?

「That would be right. If it were a 'Constellation'.」

A very old story began to flow out from my body.

The stories that had recovered a little during the three days that Yoo Joonghyuk had given them began to tell their final stories.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its storytelling!]

Like the Constellations that flickered at the last moment, all the stories of the 'Demon King of Salvation' were awakening.

「"You were the one who said you couldn't do it alone! You were the one who gathered us together! You told us all about this!"」

I listened to the voice of the story without saying a word.

「The group heard the message. Looking at Kim Dokja's fluttering hair. Looking at his long eyelashes and eyes, his white cheeks, and his sadly distorted lips. Realizing anew that Kim Dokja existed in this world with such a face.」

What kind of expression do I have on my face right now? Like Kim Dokja that day, will someone remember my current appearance?

「I want to see the ending with you all too.」

The startled night crow let go of my sleeve and flew up, screaming.

The crow had noticed. 'What' I was trying to call.

"Come! ■■■■■■!"

The sound of the space-time of the universe being torn apart. A massive suction force was generated between the cracks covering the sky.

Constellations, Outer Gods, hunting dogs. All existences in the area were disappearing into the cracks.

A cleaner that devoured the distorted probability of this <Star Stream>.

「The probability is sufficient.」

The opponent was the disaster of the highest peak of this <Star Stream>.

「If this is really the story you want, I'll show you as much as you want.」

I looked up at it, barely suppressing the trembling of my whole body.

‘Indescribable Distance’.

The Nameless Mist.

Judging by its size, it seemed to be a powder rather than a main body, but for now, the powder alone was enough.

[Run away! Everyone—!]

The Constellations began to scatter as the disaster devouring probability appeared. In an instant, the fog of 'Indescribable Distance' grew in size and swallowed up the entire universe. As I watched the fog slowly approaching to bite me, I thought of the main story of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

In the main story, when the 'Demon King of Salvation' was in danger of being eaten by the 'Indescribable Vastness', there was a God from another world who saved him.

「Secretive Plotter.」

It would be a lie if I said I didn't expect it at all.

Maybe he would come back. Maybe he would save me here, just like he did in the original.

However, I knew it was a vain expectation. So I called out more possible modifiers.

"Jecheon Daeseong! Please help me! I offered the meat of the Nagak!"

Anyone would do.

"Abyssal Black Flame Dragon! Have you forgotten that low-level dragon heart? We're both dragons, so help us!"

I wish even just one Constellation would respond. Please, in this damned Star Stream.

I want to live.

I shouted and shouted until my throat burst. The moment the fog that had surged in was finally about to eat away at my entire body, someone wrapped around me.

A hard back.

I spoke while being carried helplessly on that back.

"Why didn't you go?"

Then the owner of that back spoke.

"There's still something I have to get from you."

The 41st Yoo Joonghyuk did not return to Earth. He refused Uriel's offer and stayed here.

Through [Recovery], I could hear the sound of his heart racing.

With all his remaining life, he started to run while limping.

"Is there no other way?"

This guy really seemed to believe that there was something he could do for me until the very end.

I smiled bitterly at that foolish Regressor and answered.

"No."

"I see."

"But it's not over, you know? I might go to the afterlife."

"I've never been there when I'm dead."

I wish I had a little more time to write the story.

"Now that I'm not a Regressor, I might go this time. Let's start over from there. The goal is to cause a revolution in the Underworld and take away the giant soldier 'Pluto'. How is it?"

"That can't be possible—"

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me as if he couldn't believe it, then muttered as he looked ahead.

"I wish there was."

No matter how much he ran, it was impossible for Yoo Joonghyuk to escape from the 'Indescribable Distance'.

Even so, Yoo Joonghyuk didn't give up. He ran without giving up, just like he always did.

I felt sorry for him.

I wonder if there are any sentences left for me to save him. But I have to try everything I can.

[Exclusive skill '□□' activates!]

The world's scenery slowed down and the final argument began.

However, I didn't know what sentence to use to save Yoo Joonghyuk. No matter how much I imagined, I couldn't picture a future where we could escape.

I thought that maybe this might be the end of the 41st Round. Our fate is to disappear without being read properly, without even being left as a proper story.

[Warning! The skill is not being used smoothly due to the collapse of the incarnation body!]

[You have very little space.]

To make matters worse, the number of characters given to me was less than twenty.

Just twenty characters.

How could I persuade the world with those twenty characters? How could I make them read a story that no one reads?

The moment I thought that far, a light came on in my head.

A story that no one reads.

And I completed a single sentence.

「This is a story about despair that cannot be read.」

That was all I could write.

A sentence that could probably change nothing.

To say that a story cannot be read is a story that cannot be read.

And yet, I thought.

This is enough. I was sure that if it was the reader I knew—if it was him who loved this story more than anyone else—he would definitely read this sentence.

[Successfully recreated the scene.]

[Exiting 'Snowfield'.]

The fog of 'Indescribable Distance' engulfed us.

Yoo Joonghyuk started running with all his might.

[A new story begins to sprout!]

With each desperate step of his, sentences that I could not write continued.

「Even if it is not read, I will not give up.」

I read that line, recalling the footprints of a person left in the Snowfield.

「Just by not giving up, a story becomes a tale.」

I hope this story reaches beyond the universe.

But the speed of the fog that was creeping up was faster than I thought, and we were finally caught up by the fog.

"Kim Dokja—"

At that moment, I felt my stomach churn.

Something was coming.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

We instinctively crouched down. A vast storm of light surged around us.

My head felt dizzy. Yoo Joonghyuk, who was staggering, lost sight of me.

We looked back, floating in the weightlessness of the scenario. The fog that had covered us until then was dispersing in a dazzling flash of light. Between the magnificently dispersing fog, a magnificent view of the dying universe unfolded.

There was nothing left where the light had passed.

No Constellations, no other worldly deities, nothing.

Soon, a single sentence rose above the universe that had spread out like a new blank space.

「It looked like some kind of period.」

Upon closer inspection, it wasn't a period.

A man was watching us in the landscape of destruction.

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A faint thunderclap was heard in the clear sky. A faint hint of an aftershock. A small spark that popped up and dyed the sky for a moment, then quickly disappeared.

Yoo Joonghyuk, sitting on the bed, muttered as he looked up at the sky.

"Probability aftermath."

It couldn't have happened.

There was no way something like a 'probability aftermath' would have come in here, not in another world.「This is a story about despair that cannot be read.」

"Captain. What are you talking about? Are you half asleep?"

Lee Jihye grabbed Yoo Joonghyuk’s arm and dragged him out of bed.

"Have you forgotten what day it is today? Wait for the kid!"

Yoo Joonghyuk silently got up from his seat and took out his coat from his clothes.

Come to think of it, today was an important day.

Lee Jihye got angry at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was naturally putting on his coat.

"Captain! Are you crazy? Are you going to wear that black coat today?"

"There’s also a white one."

"Black and white! Captain, you can’t wear that Constellation fashion today. You’re no longer 'Secretive Plotter'!"

"I—"

"Please be ordinary! Dress as inconspicuously as possible! All the parents are coming, so you want to show off your baby?"

"…"

"Oh, really. Before Uriel unnie left for work, she told me so earnestly— Why is there only the same coat in the closet?"

Lee Jihye grumbled and naturally started searching through Lee Hyunsung's closet.

"Why is this guy only in his military uniform!"

"Lee Hyunsung is a soldier."

"No, soldiers only wear military uniforms?"

Lee Jihye finally found a suit that wasn't a military uniform in Lee Hyunsung's closet. It was a suit.

"Here, wear this!"

Yoo Joonghyuk accepted the suit that Lee Jihye handed him without saying a word.

Lee Jihye nodded in satisfaction as she watched Yoo Joonghyuk quickly get dressed.

"It suits you well."

"It's not a good outfit for combat."

"Why fight? Let's go quickly. We don't have much time."

Today was the day of the parent observation class. In case they were late, the two quickly looked around and started running through the air with [Jujak Shinbo].

"It's gloomy weather."

"It's sunny, what are you talking about, really?"

It took less than 5 minutes to get to school. The two of them, who had lightly adjusted their clothes in order to avoid being noticed as much as possible, entered the schoolyard in a jiffy.

Judging from the mess in the classroom, it seemed like class was already in progress. The teacher who was waiting outside happened to notice the two.

"Are you here to observe as parents?"

When Yoo Joonghyuk nodded, the teacher smiled slightly and asked again.

"Is your kid's name..."

"Kim Dokja."

"Oh, you're Dokja's parents!"

Lee Jihye, who thought she would be misunderstood the worst if things continued like this, quickly stepped forward.

"This person is his uncle. I'm his older sister."

"Oh. I see. Would you like to come this way?"

She followed the teacher's instructions.

As they entered the classroom, they saw a group of parents gathered at the back of the classroom.

Some parents noticed Yoo Joonghyuk and Lee Jihye and chatted, or even glanced at Yoo Joonghyuk’s face.

However, most of them were just standing there, yawning repeatedly, bored.

The two of them sat down near the lockers and observed the students.

The students were each drawing on their we drawing paper under the guidance of the art teacher.

The small backs of their heads were gathered here and there.

Yoo Joonghyuk quickly found the one that was most familiar among the backs of their heads.

"It’s amazing to see sometimes."

Lee Jihye, who happened to be looking at the same back of the head, said.

"It’s amazing to think of so many things with that small head."

Time passed quickly.

The students submitted their drawings one by one. Every time a drawing was submitted, the teacher called the parents over with an exaggerated gesture and talked to them.

"Wow, what did you draw?"

Even as the students who had finished submitting their work were chatting with their parents and leaving the classroom, Yoo Joonghyuk saw a small head still buried in the desk.

Just as he was worried that his head might get sucked into the desk, the teacher made their move first.

"Dokja. Time's up."

"Just a moment."

Now, only Yoo Joonghyuk and Lee Jihye were left in the back of the classroom.

The teacher, who had noticed the two, smiled brightly and asked.

"Father. Would you like to come over here and take a look?"

Yoo Joonghyuk approached him.

However, Kim Dokja, who was so focused that he didn't even notice him approaching, was absorbed in his drawing.

The teacher asked.

"What are you drawing?"

"Space."

"Space?"

As Kim Dokja had said, the background of the drawing was pitch-black space. Space with faint starlight scattered about.

Three people were standing in that space.

The teacher, who had been looking back and forth between the drawing and Yoo Joonghyuk several times, asked.

"Is this by any chance your father?"

"Hmm."

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at Kim Dokja's painting. There was definitely a man with the exact same face as him.

A man covered in blood all over his body, glaring at the world with hateful eyes.

Yoo Joonghyuk immediately recognized who he was. He couldn't not know.

'41st.'

Because that Yoo Joonghyuk, was the Yoo Joonghyuk who most resembled himself.

Next to him stood a man wearing a pure white coat.

His hair was a bit lighter than he remembered, but this time, Yoo Joonghyuk immediately recognized who he was.

"Who is this?"

Kim Dokja answered with an embarrassed expression.

"It's me from another world."

"Oh my, this is a profound painting."

The two people in the painting looked very tired, as if they had been fighting someone just a moment ago.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the two people in the painting for a long time, as if he was reflecting on the old times.

In the meantime, the teacher's gaze turned to the last person in the painting.

"Then... who is the naked person next to him?"

There was a naked man holding a sword.

Yoo Joonghyuk also looked at the man.

However, the moment he looked at the man, he felt as if the man in the painting was looking at him.

"Captain."

Only then did Lee Jihye notice something was wrong, and her face changed. She looked at Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk continued to look down at the man in the painting without answering, and then suddenly looked up into the sky.

Tsk tsk tsk.

The aftershock of the sky that he had witnessed earlier was heard once again.

Looking at that spark, Secretive Plotter opened his mouth without realizing it.

"Still."

At first glance, a longed-for starlight seemed to twinkle across the vast expanse of space.

Staring at that starlight, Secretive Plotter said.

"It seems there are stories left that I haven't read."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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전지적
독자시점
싱숑 현대 판타지 소설

# 795 Episode 38 Chance (1)

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「All coincidences are probable from the universe's perspective.」

— Dokkaebi King

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I don't know if I've ever talked about that writer.

「"Please put coincidences in unconditionally. The more the better. Please give them to the main character."」

The lecturer of the first web novel lecture I ever heard. Because he emphasized 'coinciding with coincidences' in every class, the students used to call him ‘Giyeon’ for short.

[NOTE 1]

Because he was older than me, I called him 'Giyeon hyung', but one day, the one I used to call 'Giyeon hyung' suddenly disappeared from the industry.

Some said that he started writing under a different pen name, and others said that he left the industry altogether. There were also people who mocked him, saying that he must have been reincarnated into another world and met Giyeon in that world.

However, no one actually knew what happened to Giyeon hyung.

But actually, I have something to say about his disappearance. Two years before he went missing, he contacted me.

—Hakhyun-ah. Do you want to work on a project together?

He contacted me right when his next project was a complete failure. I was happy to hear his call, but at the same time, I felt uncomfortable.

—Hyung, our styles are so different.

Collaborating on a project.

Usually, writers in their right minds wouldn't do something like that. Not only would 'collaborating' not work well between writers with strong egos, but it often ends up being a negative when two people write together.

Furthermore, it's not a structure where you can make more money through collaboration.

—Honestly, I'm not sure I can do it well. It'll just be a nuisance.

—No. I need your help. Can we work together just once?

Was it because the voice on the other end of the phone was desperate? Or was it because this month's management fee came to mind?

Even though I knew I shouldn't do it, I couldn't resist the temptation.

—I really don't have confidence… Then how do you work?

—I'll write the first draft. Then you can look at it. If it fails, I'll fail, so don't worry.

—But hyung, you'll give the main character ten coincidences from the beginning, right?

—Hey. I've changed now. I won't give the main character coincidence anymore.

Giyeon hyung doesn't use coincidence?

I thought it was a joke, but I was curious anyway.

—What's the genre?

—It's a modern fantasy, but I'll arrange it with a mix of martial arts and systems. Actually, I haven't drawn up a specific worldview. Since you're good at that, I'd like some help.

—You're not telling me to draw it all, are you?

—I said it's a collaboration. We'll draw it together, but you'll lay the ground-work. What do you think?

—Okay.

—Okay, let me ask you a favor. I think my senses are old now, so I'm not good at making trendy settings, so I'll give you a decent ratio.

As I listened, it was a tempting suggestion. Some ideas just popped into my head.

—Do you have a rough plot?

—Well, there's no worldview yet. Just because a tower suddenly appeared in the world…

—The tower climbing genre is a thing of the past.

—That's true, but wouldn't it be okay to make the main character a little more unique?

—What abilities are you going to give him?

—Let's not give him any abilities.

No abilities?

—He trains hard without any abilities and becomes strong. It's time for the classic hard-working main character to return.

There are many such main characters now, but there weren't many back then.

—How about training hard in just stabbing?

I guess that's why.

At that time, I found his idea very interesting.

—Well, yes.

When I think back to those days, I often think this.

Maybe all the stories in this world are connected.

We just don’t notice it, but maybe all writers are contributing to a 'huge piece of work' in ways we never thought of.

—Um, then what about the title…

The moment I heard these words, a title came to mind as if by fate. I thought that no other title would suit this story.

—『The World After The Fall』. How is it?

Several years have passed since that day.

『The World After The Fall』, which we wrote together, was completed with modest results after many twists and turns, but even so, that writer, who could not endure the hardships of life, disappeared somewhere.

I don’t know where he went. However, the royalties that came in occasionally told me that the work we wrote was being read by someone.

"Kim Dokja."

With those royalties, I was able to eat, pay management fees, and pay rent.

I was able to continue my life as a writer.

That’s why a parody of 『The World After The Fall』 appears in 『Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint』.

Courtesy towards the writer who I wrote with. Or, I hope that he is still reading and writing novels somewhere in this world.

When I think about it now, there are times when all of that feels like a lie.

Was 『The World After The Fall』 really a novel we wrote?

Maybe he and I were just nameless scribes who received and wrote down dreams from some distant universe.

"Kim Dokja!"

I suddenly came to my senses at Yoo Joonghyuk's shout.

"Ah."

I suddenly looked behind me.

The empty void of space lay there. The Nebulae that had threatened us until then, and the Gods of the Other World, were all swept away.

In that magical moment of emptiness, I clearly witnessed the flash of light that swept them all away with my own two eyes.

A stab.

It was definitely a stab.

"Be careful."

With those words, Yoo Joonghyuk stepped forward in front of me. His body had become tattered since he came here. Watching him step forward with such a body, I also stood next to him.

"I've never seen this guy before."

Yoo Joonghyuk's expression, which was sullen, was shaking with agitation.

Have I ever seen 'Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st Round' so tense?

The dot that had seemed like a period was getting bigger and bigger. The dot soon took the shape of a man. What was a little unusual was that the man was naked. I could tell without anyone saying anything. He was the main character who used 'stab'.

The moment our eyes met, I felt like the fluff on my entire body was going to burn. It felt like huge eyes were watching me.

A huge and intense eye that stared into space.

I had never felt this way even when I faced the Constellations of the highest level.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Do you believe in fate?"

"What?"

A naked man holding a sword finally arrived in front of us. He looked back at the two of us with a leisurely gaze and muttered.

"Are you those guys?"

Those guys. It was as if he knew us.

"It's just as he said."

The man's eyes, filled with deep disappointment, stared at me for a moment before turning to Yoo Joonghyuk.

"I expected it to be bad."

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned and twitched his lips.

I stepped forward before anything unexpected could happen.

"The 'Monarch Slayer' Jaehwan! Is that it?"

The man's expression changed subtly at my words.

"Do you know me?"

Of course I could not help but know.

He was the main character of 『The World After The Fall』 that I had written with Kiyeon.

The absolute being of the worldview 《Tree of Imaginary》.

The Monarch Slayer Jaehwan.

Now, the main character of that story that we couldn't even tell if we had written was looking at me.

"Is there anyone in this universe who doesn't know your name?"

"It's not this universe where I'm famous?"

"Let's say it's the universe next door."

He even had a history of encountering Kim Dokja, who had become the 'Oldest Dream', while wandering around on the subway.

Well, it wasn't a good memory for either of them.

In any case, the important thing is that he had appeared in 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

—Kim Dokja.

I could hear Yoo Joonghyuk's [Midday Tryst], which seemed quite tense.

—A being that is on par with a mythical grade Constellation.

A Mythical grade Constellation.

The Constellations that occupy the highest positions among the stars in this <Star Stream>. Right now, Yoo Joonghyuk was saying that the man was as strong as them, or even stronger.

I don’t know why the monarch killer came here. But this was our opportunity.

"Please. Please help me."

"What?"

"I need your help."

I never thought I would have to ask him for help. But there was no other way.

[You have been expelled from the scenario.]

With a 'tsk tsk' sound, the probability staggered around.

The incarnation body that had been stable for a moment was shaking once again.

[Enter the new main scenario.]

[If you fail to obtain the new main scenario, you will die.]

I had forgotten for a moment. I died in place of the Demon King of Salvation at the 'Recycling Center', and in return, I became a 'Scenario Exile'.

Just like Kim Dokja of the Demon World, my incarnation body would disintegrate if I didn’t enter the new scenario.

Jaehwan, who was quietly looking at me, asked.

"Why should I help you?"

Judging from the way he spoke, he seemed to be Yoo Joonghyuk's ancestor.

However, seeing that the conversation continued, there was still hope.

"You helped me just now, didn't you?"

"I didn't help you. I just got rid of those who were interfering with my training."

Training?

When I focused my vision, I saw an energy rippling all over his body. A sharp awl extending toward the world. It was an energy that seemed to symbolize 'stabbing'.

It was creepy. Even at this moment, he was repeatedly stabbing the world.

Stabbing hundreds, maybe thousands of times per second.

If I were to visualize the concept of 'stabbing', would it look like that?

"If you guys keep interfering, I'll kill you too."

An eerie warning.

Normally, it would be normal to leave immediately. The opponent was a being that could compete with a 'Mythical Constellation'.

Kukukukukuku.

A seething noise from the other side of the void. I could feel the tension between the minions of the Nebula who had not yet given up on us and the gods of the other world.

Right now, they are keeping an eye out because of this man, but the moment we open up even a little distance, they will come rushing back like lynxes.

My intuition was telling me. I have to buy some more time, somehow.

"Is there a reason you are training so hard when you are so strong?"

Jaehwan did not answer, but I continued to ask.

"Who did you come here to meet?"

I pondered his nature and asked again.

"Or do you want a strong 'enemy'?"

'Jaehwan, the Monarch Slayer' was a man with a stronger competitive spirit than anyone else. He stabbed and killed all the monarchs and gods who reigned over 《Tree of Imaginary》, and eventually destroyed the universe he belonged to. Maybe he was interested in the strong people of this universe.

Jaehwan slowly raised his head, and a faint emotion filled his eyes.

"Is there such a being?"

"I'll let you fight them."

I didn't use [Incite]. I instinctively knew that [Incite] wouldn't work on the being in front of me. Right now, the only thing I could trust was my own three-inch tongue.

Fortunately, Jaehwan looked a little interested.

"How?"

"We're being chased by the Constellations of the <Star Stream> right now."

Perhaps this might be the perfect opportunity to eliminate our enemies. If only we could make this being, who is approaching the ' Myth-grade Constellation', our ally.

I took a few deep breaths and continued.

"Just by being with us, all the strong people of the <Star Stream> will come looking for you."

"Are you trying to use me?"

"We're just giving each other a little help. Just allow me to stay by your side."

Anyway, if I let him go here, I would be in a situation where I would have no food or shelter. Since the hilt was over there, I thought it would be better to be honest about the situation rather than trying to convince him with nonsense.

Jaehwan looked at me without answering. Then he slowly turned his head and looked behind me.

When did it start?

The Nameless Things that had been watching from afar were once again expanding their forces and coming forward.

"It's annoying."

He swung his sword into the air, his voice uncertain whether positive or negative. Another flash of light struck, and the surroundings became quiet. It was truly an eerie sense of inaction.

Jaehwan, who had gotten up from his seat, slowly began to move somewhere.

I signaled to Yoo Joonghyuk to chase after him.

But Yoo Joonghyuk didn't respond at all.

When I looked back, Yoo Joonghyuk was unconscious. I belatedly noticed his broken knee and the wounds.

It was only natural.

It was a brave situation to have held out this long even after using [Recovery]. I picked up Yoo Joonghyuk and started chasing after Jaehwan. Fortunately, he moved just fast enough for us to keep up. I took that as his consent.

Was this a coincidence?

What would Kiyeon have said if he had seen that man's back?

[Your incarnation body is unstable.]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' warns you.]

'I understand, so don't whine.'

The lifespan of my incarnation body was decreasing in real time. From now on, it was a race against time.

While chasing after that 'Monarch Slayer', I had to somehow find a way to get back to the 'main scenario'.

The Monarch Slayer Jaehwan muttered without looking back.

"One week. No more."

I nodded while carrying Yoo Joonghyuk, who had become a rag.

"One week is enough."

We will never die. At least not until we change the damn ending of this universe.

I started walking diligently, following his footsteps left in the void.

[NOTE 2]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: ‘Giyeon’ means 'Coincidence'.

Note [2]: Image of the character Jeahwan - Monarch Slayer from The World After the Fall (It is another work of the author Sing N Song, which they introduced in ORV)

# 796 Episode 38 Chance (2)

The back of Jaehwan, who was walking a few steps ahead, was blurry.

Walking, stopping for a moment to rest, and walking again.

I repeated that simple task while carrying Yoo Joonghyuk who had fallen.

[Your incarnation body is unstable.]

[Warning. Enter a new 'scenario'.]

It wasn't some kind of health alert, and I smiled bitterly as I heard the same message intermittently.

Who wouldn't enter the 'main scenario' without knowing?

「I wonder if it was a mistake to intentionally fail the 'scenario'?」

An old sentiment came flooding back, but I didn't really regret it.

At that time, it was the best choice.

Failing the scenario and being stripped of the status of 'Constellation'. And thus being banished outside the scenarios.

That was the only way to save all the readers, including the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

[Your incarnation body is unstable.]

The cough that I spit out left a trail of stories.

[Your incarnation body is breaking apart.]

A body that would not be strange if it collapsed at any moment. Nevertheless, my incarnation body still managed to maintain its shape.

[Exclusive trait effect is activated.]

[The effect of the exclusive trait 'Record Repairer' delays the collapse of your incarnation body.]

Exclusive trait 'Record Repairer'.

This trait, which was activated by collecting a certain amount of 'Kim Dokja Fragments', had a certain level of immunity effect only against the collapse of the incarnation body.

Of course, this trait alone was not enough to withstand the collapse.

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is activating.]

The [Fourth Wall]. Kim Dokja's main skill, and the skill that saved him from danger every time, if this skill hadn't been activated in time, I would have passed out without being able to overcome the pain.

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is strongly activated.]

I imagined the 'Demon King of Salvation' and the Kkoma Kim Dokja beyond this wall.

People who still liked this story even after going through that terrible scenario together.

「Kim Dokja thought.」

They were talking.

「We have to survive.」

With a thud, the story flowed back once more.

How many more times did I vomit stories like that?

Jaehwan, who had been walking far away, stopped walking. It seemed like he was going to take a short break.

I laid Yoo Joonghyuk down on a stone floating around.

Is it the effect of the 'Summoning Squad' I had fed him earlier? Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation was quickly recovering.

The deep wound below his kneecap was also slowly healing.

After all, the main character is the main character.

If this continues, Yoo Joonghyuk will be able to finish recovering and return to the scenario in a few days.

The problem is that I don't know if I will be alive by then.

[Your incarnation body is unstable.]

I felt drowsy once in a while, and every time I did, a terrible cold air came over me.

I must not lose consciousness.

I desperately recalled Kim Dokja's story.

Sometimes, Kim Dokja had experienced something similar to me.

「If I don't quickly save my incarnation body and seal my wounds, all my stories will collapse and I will die.」

I imagined Kim Dokja walking alone on the horizon of the stories. Kim Dokja walking alone in the world without a star's gaze or a scenario.

He ate the story fragments on the horizon of the stories, and used them to repair his incarnation body and overcome the crisis.

How did 'Kim Dokja' absorb the story fragments back then?

「Lamarck's Giraffe.」

That's right. Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation', clearly had such a trait. If that's the case, then I can also use that trait.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' looks at you with displeasure.]

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' grumbles and begins its storytelling.]

After a while, a light bulb turned on in my head, and the trait was activated.

[You can now temporarily use the exclusive attribute 'Lamarck's Giraffe'.]

Lamarck's Giraffe.

With this trait, Kim Dokja was able to temporarily restore his incarnation body by absorbing small 'story fragments'.

The problem is that I don't have any remaining 'story fragments' to use for restoration.

That's when the sound of a vacuum cleaner could be heard from afar.

A flock of 'Nameless Things' swimming through space. Behind the guys who were scurrying around the void like a school of mackerel, a monster with a fierce appetite could be seen. An eerie presence that could be clearly felt from afar.

A God from Outer World. The shark-headed alien with a human body was disturbing the group like a predator, biting the 'Nameless Things'.

I really hoped it wouldn't look this way, but this time, the <Star Stream> betrayed my expectations.

【Ooooooooo】

The alien's cries made my mind dizzy. The guy who quickly wiggled his fins rushed towards me with his fearsome teeth flashing.

A murderous feeling that made my spine tingle.

The moment I instinctively grabbed the hilt of 'Unbreakable Faith' sword, a flash of light flashed before my eyes.

Jaehwan swung his sword.

The shark alien that had opened its mouth wide disappeared with its head exploding.

It was an unbelievable act of inaction. Even if it wasn't at the level of the 'Dream Eater', it seemed like an outer deity with its own name.

In any case, now was not the time to be completely surprised. This was because the fragments of the outer deity's legend floating in the void caught my eye.

[Exclusive trait 'Lamarck's Giraffe' reacts.]

Most of them were contaminated or damaged and unusable, but there were some that I could consume now.

I sneakily looked at Jaehwan's expression and asked.

"Can I eat that?"

Jaehwan glanced at me indifferently and quickly turned his head away.

I quickly approached the Shark's story fragment. I saw a story fragment that looked exactly like a shark's fin.

[Story fragment 'Rapid Swim' rejects your touch.]

[The story in question is contaminated.]

[Eating the story in question may cause side effects.]

Judging from the strong fishy smell, it seemed like it would be difficult to eat it as it was even if I utilized 'Lamarck's Giraffe'.

After thinking for a moment, I searched through the arms of the unconscious Yoo Joonghyuk.

Let's see, if my thoughts are right, he should have 'that item'. After a while, something like a small seasoning container was caught in my fingertips.

I checked the item information.

**<Item Information>**

Name: All-purpose special seasoning

Grade: A+

Description: Essence made from natural ingredients of the <Star Stream>. When sprayed, anything becomes edible. The recipe has not been revealed.

As expected, Yoo Joonghyuk.

I didn't have high expectations, but I didn't know this item really existed.

「All-purpose special seasoning. It's an item developed by Yoo Joonghyuk in the second round for emergency cooking. He himself doesn't use it often.」

Why do people carry around things like this and not use them? I don't know.

I roughly sprinkled the special seasoning on the still fluttering fins, then took a deep breath and swallowed it.

The snow shard tasted like ramen soup sprinkled on the shark fin.

[Exclusive trait 'Lamarck's Giraffe's effect activates!]

[Story fragment 'Rapid Swim' refuses to .!]

The story fragment that entered my stomach began to shake. My stomach rumbled as if I had an emergency. However, I couldn't just spit it out.

[Your incarnation body is in danger.]

If I spit this out now, I'll die. So I have to swallow it. I have to grit my teeth and get through it somehow.

That's when someone hit my back with a thud. It hurt so much I screamed, so I turned around and saw Jaehwan there.

Why are you suddenly hitting someone? Are you a psychopath?

Jaehwan looked at me for a moment without answering, then walked over and sat down nearby, sitting cross-legged.

Only then did I realize why he had hit my back.

[Your digestive ability is enhanced.]

[Exclusive trait 'Lamarck's Giraffe' is strongly activated.]

[Story fragment 'Rapid Swim' has been absorbed.]

Could it be that he's helping me now? Not someone else, but 'Monarch Slayer' Jaehwan?

[Your incarnation body temporarily regains stability.]

I felt my hunger disappearing quickly and my incarnation body recovering. I thought I could easily last another day or two at this rate.

"I, thank you."

I bowed my head toward Jaehwan. Jaehwan pretended not to hear me and closed his eyes.

Is he repeating his mental stabbing toward the universe again?

What on earth is he trying to stab with all that effort?

I looked at Jaehwan for a moment and then muttered while examining Yoo Joonghyuk's details again.

"You say thank you too."

Of course, Yoo Joonghyuk, who had passed out, didn't answer. It had been a while since I'd seen him sleeping so soundly. Even now, it seems like it was just yesterday that I was thrown under the bridge at Oksu Station, but I realized that a lot has happened since then.

While going back and forth between the Washington Dome and the Recycling Center, Yoo Joonghyuk became a black beast, and also a little Yoo Joonghyuk wearing a red hat. He almost died several times, and in the end, this is what happened.

Damn bastard. Why did you chase me all the way here? This didn't happen even in the Third Round.

If he hadn't come to save me, Yoo Joonghyuk would have cleared the 'Recycling Center' without a hitch and started growing. His transcendence would have been higher, and he would have moved on to the next scenario without a hitch with the readers of Earth.

I ruined everything.

So I have to save this guy.

After feeding Yoo Joonghyuk the 'summoning squad' that I had divided up, I took a breather for a moment.

While he was eating the remaining summoning squad crumbs, my eyes met with Jaehwan's, who was looking at me.

Why is he looking? I feel uneasy.

I recalled the information about him in my head.

「The Monarch Slayer Jaehwan.」

Fortunately, since 『The World After The Fall』 was a work I was involved in, I remembered quite a bit of information about him.

For example, if someone asked me, "Who is Jaehwan?", I could answer like this.

「The protagonist who destroys the world by stabbing while naked.」

After summarizing, he seems like the type of person you should never get entangled with.

I thought for a moment and held out the summoning crumbs to Jaehwan.

"Would you like some?"

When you first become close, isn't it best to share food?

Whether he was naked or destroyed the world by stabbing, it was something that happened in his universe.

And in this <Star Stream>, he saved me twice.

Who knows? Maybe that 'Monarch Slayer' became a little kinder under the influence of the <Star Stream> worldview.

"You eat it."

I felt a familiar comfort in his sharp answer and asked back.

"What do you usually eat?"

"I don't eat anything in particular."

"If you don't eat anything, you die."

Jaehwan didn't answer and just stared at me. Thanks to someone, I was already used to that kind of gaze.

I shook the seasoning bottle and smiled.

"If there's anything you want, I'll make it for you. There's some good seasoning here."

I didn't really plan on cooking. I'm not Yoo Joonghyuk from the 81st Round of 'Ways of Survival', so what kind of food would I cook in this 'change of scenario'? Even if I made it, it would be nothing more than 'Foreign Correspondent Shark's Fin who died from a brutal stabbing'.

But I wanted to talk to that man who was hard to get close to, even like this.

My life and Yoo Joonghyuk's life depended on that good-natured psychopath for the next week.

If he changed his mind and stabbed us to death right now, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' would end here.

"The kind of food I want to eat?"

Huh?

"No one can make it now."

I was a little taken aback by his answer. I never imagined that the 'Monarch Slayer' would have a food he wanted to eat.

"What kind of food is it?"

If possible, I was going to refer to 'Yoo Joonghyuk from the 81st round's recipe and make it. If I didn't have the ingredients, I could just raid Yoo Joonghyuk's coat pockets.

Jaehwan stared into space for a moment as if recalling a distant memory, then opened his mouth.

"Dumplings."

I looked at him for a moment, wondering if I had heard wrong.

What did you say just now?

"It's a food called 'Murim Dumplings'."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 797 Episode 38 Chance (3)

Unfortunately, the recipe for 「Murim Dumplings」 did not exist among the knowledge I had.

If it had been Yoo Joonghyuk, a cooking expert in the 81st Round, or Yoo Joonghyuk in the 999th Round who had experience in making Murim dumplings, they might have known the recipe…

"I like them too. Murim dumplings."

"Have you ever eaten them?"

For the first time, curiosity appeared in Jaehwan's eyes.

I nodded vigorously, surprised that even this person had curiosity.

"No."

Jaehwan looked at me like I was crazy and asked.

"How can you like food you've never eaten?"

"You don't have to eat it to like it, right?"

"What?"

I've never eaten Murim dumplings, but I've drawn countless scenes of 'Murim dumplings eating'. While I was sketching scenes of Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk eating Murim dumplings in Murim and Seoyuki, I also ate hundreds of Murim dumplings in my head.

With my eyes closed, I recited the taste of Murim dumplings from 『The World After the Fall』 and 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 at length.

After talking like that, I felt full, as if I had really eaten a whole plate of dumplings.

When I opened my eyes, Jaehwan was looking at me in disbelief.

"You really talk like someone who has eaten them."

"Isn't the most perfect 'martial arts dumpling' the 'Murim dumplings that I have not yet eaten'?"

Above all, in front of me now is a person who has actually eaten Murim dumplings through that description.

I patted Yoo Joonghyuk on the head and said.

"He probably knows better about taste. By the way, this guy's favorite food is also 'Murim dumplings'."

Jaehwan glared at Yoo Joonghyuk as if he couldn't believe what I said, and then said,

"So what do you want me to do?"

"I'll let you eat it again. That 'Murim dumpling'."

The 'Murim dumpling' in Jaehwan's world was destroyed, but this world wasn't destroyed yet.

And fortunately, the recipe for that 'Murim dumpling' was still being passed down in the <First Murim>.

But Jaehwan's attitude was strange.

"I don't believe what a guy like you says."

"No, why? I can let you eat real 'Murim dumplings'. Doesn't the thought make your mouth water? If you order chicken soup and noodles and eat them together—"

"You're going to ask for something else in return, right?"

"No, I'm not going to ask for anything else. I'll just take you to where the 'Murim dumplings' are."

"You're not saying you want me to protect you until I get there?"

This is why I hate protagonists.

They're so sensitive.

"Can't I?“

"Even if I could eat 'Murim dumplings' again."

Jaehwan paused for a moment and continued.

"The 'Murim dumplings' I ate that day are no longer there."

If my sponsor was next to me, he would have complained, saying, "That’s an amazing dumpling philosophy," but right now, my 'Demon King of Salvation' content was somewhat lacking.

"You must really like Murim dumplings."

Jaehwan looked at me as if I was crazy even more than before.

With a feeling of "Tsk tsk," [The Fourth Wall] spoke in my head.

「This isn’t about dumplings.」

I thought of the 'Demon King of Salvation' watching me with pitiful eyes from beyond the wall.

"Me too."

Jaehwan turned his head and stared into the void. Just as Yoo Joonghyuk stared at the sky of the <Star Stream> whenever he had the chance, he also stared into the void whenever he had the chance. As if there was someone he missed. I remembered Jaehwan’s story a little.

Just as I and other readers were summoned to the <Star Stream>, he was the protagonist summoned to the 《Tree of Imaginary》.

Just as we went through the scenarios, he climbed a tower that looked like a tree and finally reached the top of the tower.

However, I don't know what he felt at the top of the tower or what kind of being he became.

This is because Giyeon's novel ends somewhat abstractly without describing that part in detail.

I hesitated for a moment and then asked.

"May I ask what the dumplings you ate tasted like?"

Jaehwan looked back at me without saying a word and then looked up at the sky again.

A sky where no stars watch over us.

How long had he watched the vast void of space? His sword let out a humming cry. A cry that somehow sounded sad and heartbreaking.

Jaehwan never answered.

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While traveling with Jaehwan, I asked him countless questions. At first, Jaehwan didn't answer my questions, but sometimes he would talk when he felt like it.

"Do you know how much time has passed?"

"A day has passed."

"Wow, it felt like three days. But how do you measure time?"

"I'm stabbing 3,600 times per second."

"Could you slow down the stabbing a little?"

Jaehwan glared at me expressionlessly and started stabbing again.

"Where did you live?"

I continued asking questions as well. Where did he live, whether there was a scenario in his world, whether there was a system, how long he had lived.

Some of the answers were things I already knew, and some I didn't know.

I continued asking questions in order to somehow win his favor, but also for my own sake.

[Your incarnation body is becoming unstable.]

I felt like I would lose consciousness at any moment if I didn't talk to someone.

My incarnation body was almost at its limit now. In the end, Jaehwan, who couldn't hold it in any longer, opened his mouth when the number of my questions surpassed the number of times Yoo Joonghyuk regressed.

"How long are you going to keep babbling?"

"Until you answer."

"This has nothing to do with you."

"But I still want to hear it."

"There's no story to tell a guy who's about to die."

"I'm about to die, so wouldn't it be nice to hear a fun story one last time?"

Jaehwan's lips twitched in discontent.

"It's not even that fun."

I know. Giyeon's novels weren't popular.

But it didn't matter.

"I've read a story about someone who regressed 1,863 times. Do you think it'd be more boring than that?"

"Regression?"

For a moment, I thought, 'Oh no.' This man absolutely hated the word 'regression'.

The reason was clear.

In Jaehwan's world, all of his colleagues, except for him, had 'regressed'.

"There were guys who 'regressed' in my world, too."

"Is that so?"

I pretended not to know. Then Jaehwan added in a fierce voice.

"There was no one who did that 1,863 times."

"That's not an ordinary number."

"If someone regressed that many times, they must be a bad guy."

"That's not true."

I answered without realizing it.

Jaehwan narrowed his eyes at me and said.

"All regressors are cowards."

"Not all of them."

"Regressors abandon the present and run away. They go back to the past to steal others' achievements, steal items, and steal history."

"There are those who fought and fought to protect the present, but they had no choice but to regress."

I don't know why I became Yoo Joonghyuk's spokesman, but Jaehwan looked quite angry at my defense.

"There can't be a guy like that. All regressors are people who are so obsessed with the past that they can't properly look at the present."

"At least one guy is different."

"One guy?"

"And to me, you don’t look any different from a 'regressor'."

"What do you mean?"

A terrifying murderous aura flowed out of Jaehwan’s body.

"Aren’t you missing the taste of Murim dumplings?"

Jaehwan’s face was like the first time he had been hit. The murderous aura that had flowed out dissipated like magic.

"I-"

"No one moves forward without looking back. Sometimes, becoming a regressor isn’t such a bad thing."

Jaehwan didn’t answer for a long time, then slowly drew his sword.

His wooden sword blade stabbed the air. Stabbing, stabbing, stabbing again, how many times did he stab like that?

Jaehwan opened his mouth.

"As I said, my story won’t be fun."

"Even if it’s a story where you only stabbed for a million years, it’s okay."

"Only a million years?"

"Then how long have you been doing it?"

"…"

"It seems like it's not a time that can be done in one's right mind."

"It seems like I'm not in one's right mind."

"When you say that, it's really scary."

Jaehwan snickered. For the first time, he looked a little human, with a smile.

"Why are you curious about my story?"

"I guess I'm wondering if I can steal some of the secrets of strength."

"Do you think you can follow along if you listen?"

I know full well that I can't.

Even if he stabbed for a million years, it doesn't mean I can imitate those times.

However, I have [Bookmark].

If I can listen to his story and understand him even a little, I might really be able to steal 'his strength'.

Just like Kim Dokja stole the strength of other characters.

"I don't know. I might have a great awakening after hearing your story."

Of course, I never once received a message saying that my 'understanding has increased' during all the conversations I had with him.

He might be someone my poor brain simply couldn't understand.

Still, I thought it was worth the challenge.

"Why do you want to become stronger?"

"Well, I have to knock down all the stars in the sky."

"And then?"

"We'll see the end of this world."

Jaehwan looked at me like that and put his sword away.

"That's obvious."

"Do you have to have a special reason to become stronger?"

"Some strengths are like that."

Jaehwan's pupils glowed ominously. I could see the shape of a Möbius spinning inside his pupils.

"Anyone can become stronger if they have the will. However, strength itself betrays the will. When you become as strong as you want, you may not want to see the end of this world."

Listening to him, I thought of the Constellations in the sky.

Great people. Tales. Myths. Beings who have accumulated countless years and become stars in the sky. They must have had a time like mine.

Maybe even Jaehwan in front of me.

"I haven't thought about that."

"You should think about it now. That's probably a question that the enemies you're about to fight have thought about."

"Well, it's probably different when you enter and leave the bathroom."

Jaehwan frowned, as if my analogy was quite unpleasant.

He frowned.

"I doubt you can even enter that bathroom right now."

"That's..."

"It's not too late. Leave that guy behind and leave."

Jaehwan's eyes turned to Yoo Joonghyuk, who was sleeping.

As expected, Jaehwan knew about my condition.

"You're not in a condition to last a week."

"I know."

"If you hold on to that guy, you'll die."

My incarnation body looked like it could break at any moment.

I answered while collecting the stories that were collapsing in real time.

"Thank you for your words, but I can't leave."

"Why?"

If I somehow managed to escape to get to the 'main scenario' on my own, I could find some way.

But if that happens, Yoo Joonghyuk will be left alone in this void. And it didn't seem like that man would save Yoo Joonghyuk, who was left alone.

"Because we're comrades."

"I know that guy is a Regressor."

"…"

"Anyway, after he regresses, he won't remember you."

"That could be the case. But it could also not be the case."

I thought about Yoo Joonghyuk. From the 0th to the 1,864th Round. I thought about his will that had been repeated countless times.

"Who knows? Maybe he'll remember me again after regressing 1,863 times."

"That can't be."

"After a long regression, he might become stronger than you and come to end this whole damn world."

I briefly imagined 'Secretive Plotter' who was building up a story that had nothing to do with this story across the universe.

And then I turned my eyes to the fallen Yoo Joonghyuk again.

"And this guy won't regress. Even if he does, he has no world to return to. This world is his last world."

Yoo Joonghyuk, lying on the floating stone, curled up as if he was cold. Covering that guy with a coat, Jaehwan muttered quietly.

"A Regressor who does not regress."

With that, he did not speak any further. He was staring at the void as before, but for some reason, his expression was different from before. Maybe he was thinking of the Murim dumplings he shared with his colleagues a long time ago.

I held my breath quietly so as not to disturb his thoughts.

Yoo Joonghyuk woke up on the sixth morning. As soon as he woke up, the smell of finely ground herbal medicine tickled his nose.

'A Summoning Squad.'

It would vary depending on the market price that day, but the summoning squad was an elixir that cost more than a hundred thousand coins. Someone had fed him the medicine. Of course, it was obvious who that someone was.

'Kim Dokja.'

Kim Dokja was seen curled up on a nearby floating stone and sleeping.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at Kim Dokja for a moment, then suddenly came to his senses and grabbed his spear.

A place a few steps away. There was a man with a body staring at him from above the broken meteorite.

Was it 'Jaehwan'?

Yoo Joonghyuk carried Kim Dokja, who had fallen, while being wary of Jaehwan.

An exhausted and worn-out incarnation body.

Judging from his condition, he was in danger if he didn't repair his stories right away.

Yoo Joonghyuk thought of the places where the 'Story Expert' was nearby and took a step back.

He heard Jaehwan's voice behind him.

"Where are you going?"

"A place where I can save this guy."

"If you leave here, you guys will die."

He understood what those words meant. Even now, he could feel the presence of the stars from a great distance. The reason they weren't approaching him must have been because of the existence of 'Jaehwan' before his eyes.

Even those Giant Nebulae were afraid of the man before his eyes.

However, he couldn't keep dying here forever.

"I won't die."

Yoo Joonghyuk's condition was the best right now. As he had overcome near-death experiences, his incarnation body had become more robust, and his skills had also improved.

If it was a head-on fight, it wouldn't be fine, but if it was just running away with Kim Dokja, it would be possible.

But Jaehwan said something strange.

"It means I'm going to kill you."

"What?"

Was he really a dangerous guy?

As he instinctively raised his fighting spirit, Jaehwan continued to speak.

"If you want to leave, leave him behind. Then I'll let you go."

"What are you talking about?"

Jaehwan glanced at Kim Dokja with his characteristically expressionless eyes, and answered in his usual blunt voice.

"I'm a little interested in the 'Murim Dumplings' that guy is talking about."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 798 Episode 38 Chance (4)

Dim lighting. The smell of dry, warm letters. When I opened my eyes, I realized that I was in a bookshelf.

I fainted.

I suddenly felt alert. I absolutely could not faint. The stamina of my incarnation body was running out, and the one-week promise with Jaehwan was just around the corner.

However, no matter how many times I slapped myself, I didn't come back to my senses.

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is activating.]

A soft system message rang in my ears.

It seemed that this was inside the [Fourth Wall].

I slowly got up and saw the library in my blurry vision.

The sound of breathing could be heard quietly.

When I looked back, the small Kim Dokjas were each sitting on small chairs or sofas, sound asleep.

I checked the faces of the Kkoma Kim Dokjas one by one. When I looked closely, I saw some faces I knew among the Kkoma Kim Dokjas.

Gu Seonah, the Iron Gon woman. Old man Kim Kyungsik of Gombangdae.

The two people who were sleeping soundly with their heads together were faintly smiling, what they were dreaming about unknown.

I tried to calm my rising emotions and looked at them for a while. Then, in order not to wake them from their dreams, I slowly moved my body and looked around.

In the center of the group of Kkoma Kim Dokjas, there was a small table. On the table were newspapers scattered in a mess, and a book.

A thick black binding.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

The moment I confirmed the title of the book, I instinctively opened the bookcase. Then, the letters that the cover had been holding onto spilled out onto the paper.

「"He's dead. Inho-ssi—Dokja-ssi is dead."」

The voices of people I knew came to mind in real time.

The letters came to life before my eyes as if 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 had been activated.

Kyung Sein was speaking in the letters.

「"He's dead."」

It had been a long time since I heard such a desperate voice.

「"He died."」

It was clear who she was talking about.

There was also a strong voice that continued as if to comfort her despair.

「"Wake up, Kyung Sein. Nothing is certain yet."」

Killer King—Cha Sungwoo's voice.

「"Kim Dokja, who was the 'Demon King of Salvation' in the Book of Revelation, came back to life. Just because he was banished from the scenario doesn't mean he will die right away. He will somehow find a way. That's because he is Kim Dokja."」

「"How would you know that? Everything is different from the main story."」

My body shook with a spark.

My vision was blurry as if fog had formed. The moment I staggered and touched the table, I heard someone's voice.

「(Youngest.)」

I could immediately tell who the owner of the voice was.

「(You can rest a little more.)」

I looked back with a bitter smile.

"If I rest, people will be in danger."

Maybe because of fatigue, I couldn’t see his face well, but it was clearly my sponsor, my hyung.

I let out a sigh of relief without realizing it. My plan was successful.

He was living inside the [Fourth Wall].

「(Don’t worry. Your people are strong. You know better since you’ve been with them all this time.)」

My people.

「(You should trust them just like I trusted <Kim Dokja Company>.)」

I realized anew how difficult it is to trust someone.

I bit my lips and lowered my head.

"I’m afraid that I ruined everything. I’m afraid that more people will die because of me. Because of the sentences I wrote carelessly—"

「(A story doesn’t fall apart because of a few incorrect lines. Rather, what if a new development begins from those sentences?)」

"Can Kim Dokja say that?"

「(Don't you think 'Ways of Survival' is a perfect story?)」

"The main character of that 'Ways of Survival' is going to die because of me."

「(You don't seem to know much, but the life force of a sunfish is stronger than you think.)」

We looked at each other. Then we snickered. I tried hard to hold back the blurring of my vision.

"I thought I would never be able to have this conversation again."

I wanted to tell him that I was glad to see him again, that I was thankful that he was alive.

But there were things that could be conveyed without saying anything. It was a feeling that both he and I could feel because we were Kim Dokja. We kept our mouths shut for a moment and immersed ourselves in that feeling.

"That bastard Yoo Joonghyuk, why on earth did he chase after me?"

「(Do you think Yoo Joonghyuk came because he was worried about you? He must have an ulterior motive.)」

"Of course he would."

「(Yeah. So come to your senses. You know how poisonous and selfish that bastard is.)」

"Damn Yoo Joonghyuk."

The questions I really wanted to ask, the things I wanted to say were all scattered among the silly jokes. It was nice just to exchange such insignificant jokes.

After a brief silence, the Demon King of Salvation spoke.

「(I should have become a part of you by now.)」

"Don’t say anything ominous."

The Demon King of Salvation looked at me quietly and nodded.

「(Yes. In fact, I also want to watch your story a little more.)」

Does my sponsor know? How much strength just those words give me? How much courage I can muster just by knowing that he is watching over me?

"Of course you should watch over me. You are Kim Dokja."

「(The Constellations are watching over you, too.)」

"I know."

「(Odin and Zeus won't give up easily. They know the value of 'Kim Dokja fragments'. Especially you right now…)」

"Am I worth it to them right now?"

To be honest, I found the obsession of the Nebulae somewhat strange. I have seen Constellations and monsters that have acquired 'Kim Dokja fragments' gain levels beyond their original abilities several times, so I understand that 'Kim Dokja fragments' are valuable stories to the Constellations.

However, is our existence worth the 'existence of the Nebula' to the point where they have to sacrifice probability?

「(That's because you haven't been able to properly draw out the power of the 'Kim Dokja fragments' yet. The Nebulas have various story amplification devices.)」

Story amplification devices.

「(If the 'Kim Dokja fragments' enter a Giant Nebula, it may be possible to rewrite the history of the universe.)」

Rewriting the history of the universe.

Just hearing the words sent shivers down my spine.

What would happen if one nebula that collected all the 'Kim Dokja fragments' rewrote the entire universe of 'Ways of Survival' and 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'?

"We absolutely cannot get caught."

Thinking about it that way, it made sense that the Demon King of Salvation took the unreasonable step of 'scenario dedication'.

If the 'Demon King of Salvation' fragments had been stolen by the Constellations, something truly terrible would have happened.

「(And the Constellations aren't the only problem. If you don't repair your incarnation body right away, you'll really die.)」

"What if I go to the Demon World?"

In the main story, Kim Dokja visited the '73rd Demon World' right after becoming the 'Demon King of Salvation' and dying.

And there, he met the Demon World's clockmaker with the 'Story Expert' trait - Aileen Makefield.

"The 'Lamarck's Giraffe' trait can also be activated. If I activate this trait and get my stories repaired by Aileen, wouldn't I be able to survive? If I stay there, I'll also be able to receive the 'Revolutionary Scenario'."

It doesn't end with the Story Repair. In the end, I have to re-enter the 'Main Scenario'. Otherwise, my incarnation body will continue to break down.

Fortunately, there is the 'Revolutionary Scenario' in the 73rd Demon World, so if I re-enter the main scenario through that, my survival will be guaranteed.

「(That won't work.)」

"Huh? Why?"

「(The 73rd Demon World's scenario has already ended.)」

"The scenario ended?"

How on earth could that be? If things had gone according to plan, the 73rd Demon World's scenario should have been in full swing.

Then suddenly this thought occurred to me.

「If there had been a reader possessing someone in the 'Demon World'.」

The possibility that someone had already finished the 73rd Demon World's scenario instead of me.

It was a development I hadn't thought of, but judging from the expression on the Demon King's face, it seemed like something like that had actually happened.

It seemed like the information would consume the probability cost, so the Demon King seemed reluctant to mention it.

「(Anyway, even if I go to the Demon World this time, there won't be much to gain.)」

"I guess I'll have to give up the Revolutionary scenario as well."

Naturally, I guess I won't be able to participate in the 'Demon King Selection Tournament' scenario that follows. I had hoped that I might be able to obtain the Giant Tale of 'Spring of the Demon World', but the situation was difficult.

「(There's nothing you can do. You have to find another Giant Tale scenario.)」

"The other Giant Tale scenarios are all amazing."

Unlike the 'Demon King Selection Tournament' that occurs in the early part of the scenario, none of the other giant tale scenarios were easy.

<Olympus>'s 'Gigantomachia', <Eden>'s 'The Great Battle of the Holy Demons', and <Emperor>'s 'Journey to the West...

In the first place, they weren't even areas that could be entered at the moment, and they were all scenarios run by the 'Giant Nebulae'.

「(Haven't you seen 'Ways of Survival'? There are also Giant Tale scenarios that aren't run by the Giant Nebulae.)」

"I have. I just can't memorize it as well as anyone else."

「(How pathetic.)」

"I'm a Kim Dokja who specializes in writing rather than reading."

「(Isn't reading well the basics for writing well?)」

Judging from the way he was arguing, it seemed like my hyung had already finished researching the next scenario area.

「(I've extracted the scenes you need, so check them later. Do you still have my smartphone?)」

"Of course."

「(If we don't come to our senses, we'll be dead in no time. If we keep clashing with the Giant Nebulae like this, we're sure to lose.)」

The word 'we' resonated louder than the word 'sure to lose.'

I'm not alone.

「(And now the two of us can't do it alone. It's time to borrow the strength of the other Kim Dokjas.)」

"The other Brothers?"

My heart started to beat slowly as I watched the Demon King of Salvation nodding.

The Demon King of Salvation in front of me was the Eldest of the Kim Dokja Brothers.

In other words, it was time to meet the other Kim Dokjas. It means that it has been done.

「(I found the coordinates of the Second One.)」

"Coordinates? Can’t we just contact each other and meet?"

I was so excited that I even forgot that my incarnation body was about to disappear.

Just as the 'Demon King of Salvation' was a Constellation of the level of a legend, the second Kim Dokja must also be a Constellation with a modifier.

No, maybe it could be a Constellation of a higher level than the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"You should have talked about that first!"

If it's a Constellation, 'indirect messages' can be used.

It might be faster for them to come to us than for us to go.

Maybe they could help us when we're in trouble.

If that's the case, we wouldn't need the help of a psychopathic alcoholic man from another world.

"Contact him right now!"

But the expression on the 'Demon King of Salvation"s face, who was watching me get excited, was strangely dark.

「(But I suddenly can't contact the Second One.)」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 799 Episode 38 Chance (5)

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Second Kim Dokja can't be contacted?

"No way."

A Constellation, which was in perfect health, suddenly lost contact. Just like me, the 'Demon King of Salvation' was chased by the Nebulae, maybe something similar happened to the Second one.

「(It doesn't seem like he's in the hands of the 'Giant Nebulae' yet. The coordinates I found are outside the area of the Giant Nebulae.)」

Even so, it wasn't a situation to be at ease. It meant that the Constellation was in such a state that it couldn't even use indirect messages.

The Demon King of Salvation waved his hand as if to tell me not to worry and added.

「(I'll tell you the coordinates, so just check them first. Your condition is the priority right now.)」

That's right. In order to find the Second one, I have to be fine first.

「(And in my opinion, the current situation isn't that bad.)」

"Isn't that a line that you absolutely shouldn't say?"

In a dying incarnation body, being chased by Giant Nebulae, if I don't get a new scenario right away, I'll be destroyed.

But 'the situation isn't that bad'?

「(There's a guy protecting you.)」

"Who? That naked guy?"

「(Yeah.)」

"You haven't seen what's been going on lately."

I thought of Jaehwan's expressionless face. Those sharp eyes that looked like they'd stab me 100 times if I offended him even a little.

But the Demon King of Salvation seemed to have a different opinion than me.

「(He doesn't seem that bad of a guy.)」

"Huh?"

「(He wiped out all the guys that were chasing you. Even that 'Indescribable Distance'.)」

It was true.

「(And when you ate the story fragment and got sick, he also patted your back.)」

"That's not certain. He didn't pat me, he beat me to the point where I was almost dead."

「(You didn't die.)」

That's true.

「(Is that all? You followed him around for a week, too. He could have just gone and found the strong guys himself, so why bother bringing you around?)」

When I thought about it, it all sounded plausible, so I couldn't say anything to refute it.

「(Decisively, if he was going to kill you, he would have already killed you.)」

My mind was confused by the continuous gaslighting of the Demon King of Salvation.

Is that so? Is he actually a good guy?

If it weren't for the Demon King of Salvation who insisted on that opinion, I might have been convinced.

"No, but he's not someone you can feel safe with. Just looking at his personality, he's arrogant and shameless, just like—"

「(Like Yoo Joonghyuk?)」

"That's right. Like Yoo Joonghyuk."

The Demon King of Salvation smiled brightly.

「(Then wouldn't it be better?)」

"Yes?"

「(If the guy who resembles Yoo Joonghyuk still kept you alive, then there must be a reason for keeping you alive. So...)」

Unfortunately, the voice of the 'Demon King of Salvation' gradually became hazy. I felt myself slowly regaining consciousness, and the Demon King of Salvation tightly gripped my shoulder.

「(Don't worry, Youngest. I'll always be watching over you.)」

---

When I opened my eyes again, the surroundings were noisy. An ominous cracking sound could be heard.

When I turned my head, I saw two naked men swinging their swords at each other in the pitch-black darkness.

One of them was Jaehwan, the Monarch Slayer, needless to say, and the other was...

Am I still half-asleep?

I rubbed my eyes repeatedly out of fatigue before closing them again.

It seems I'm still half-asleep. Let's just go to sleep.

I woke up with a "Huk!" sound. Come to think of it, it wasn’t time to fall asleep.

When I opened my eyes again, the surroundings were quiet.

Was it a dream?

[Your incarnation body has temporarily regained stability.]

I felt like someone was staring at me, so I suddenly raised my upper body and saw Jaehwan staring at me from afar.

"You’re finally awake."

I rubbed my eyes again. Jaehwan was wearing clothes.

"You’re wearing clothes?"

"Is that so surprising?"

No, he was naked until recently.

"I just forgot to put on clothes for a moment."

I wanted to ask if there were people who would forget that, but I stopped because I thought I'd get stabbed 1000 times.

The smartphone in my arms vibrated. When I turned on the screen, a specific chapter of 'Ways of Survival' was loaded. It seemed like the chapter of 'Ways of Survival' that the 'Demon King of Salvation' mentioned was this part. As I was quickly reading that part, Jaehwan spoke again.

“"You broke your promise."

"What promise?"

"Didn't you say that if you were nearby, strong guys would come?"

"That's right."

"No one came."

"Hasn't it been just a few days?"

To be honest, I didn't know that no one would come this far. Still, the Constellations of the Giant Nebulae that are chasing us are supposed to at least show their shadows.

The good news is that there's still time left until the promise.

"The week we promised has already passed."

"Huh?"

Did I sleep that long?

"Today is the eleventh day. Don't you know anything?"

A cold sweat formed on my back.

That much time has really passed?

Then why is this person still here? Even…

[Your incarnation body has temporarily regained stability.]

Why did my incarnation body suddenly get better? At first, I thought it was because I absorbed the story fragments through the 'Lamark's Giraffe', but that didn't seem to be the only reason.

It felt like someone had reassembled the joints of my broken soul.

"I thought you were going to die soon, so I did a little bit of work. That should be enough to last another week."

This time, I really thought I had misheard.

Was that 'Monarch Slayer' saying something right?

"Did you save me?"

Jaehwan didn't answer.

I was a little touched and impressed, and asked.

"Did you also have the ability to repair stories?"

"Repair stories?"

Now that I think about it, I guess we don't use that word because our worldviews are different.

"I just applied a little bit of the technique called [Dead Man Slash]."

"[Dead Man Slash]?"

"It's a technique I learned from the old man Cheonghuh, the God of Despair. It restores souls polluted by time..."

I wonder if he was recalling old memories.

Jaehwan's eyes deepened for a moment before returning.

"Forget it, you won't know anyway."

"Since I don't know, I want to hear more details."

"That's not interesting?"

"But I still want to hear it."

Jaehwan looked at me clearly and said.

"You're a strange guy."

"I hear that often."

"That guy over there was just as strange as you."

That guy?

I turned my head following Jaehwan's gaze and saw Yoo Joonghyuk lying on a small floating stone.

But Yoo Joonghyuk's condition was a bit strange.

"Why did this strange guy get so small?"

Yoo Joonghyuk was back to being a small boy. His coat was torn here and there, as if he had been in a fierce battle, and he was repairing himself.

What on earth happened?

"He attacked me."

I don't know how many times I doubted my ears today.

Yoo Joonghyuk attacked him? That person? Why on earth? I thought that Yoo Joonghyuk could do that, but on the other hand, I couldn't understand why he would make that choice.

Yoo Joonghyuk has a fiery personality. However, his flames burn endlessly and coldly. He's not the kind of guy who would pick a fight he has no chance of winning.

That guy attacked Jaehwan. He even risked the side effect of becoming a kid again.

"I made a bet."

"A bet?"

"I said I'd spare your life if he hurt me even a little."

Upon closer inspection, I saw a faint scar on Jaehwan's hand.

I shivered.

That Yoo Joonghyuk had finally succeeded. He had won a bet with that absolute being that could even beat a Mythical-grade Constellation.

No, wait. Then could that scene in my dream have been real?

I thought of Jaehwan and Yoo Joonghyuk swinging their swords naked, and touched my temple.

What on earth was that bastard Yoo Joonghyuk thinking? I could have really died.

Why did he make a bet with someone who could tear us apart at any time if he wanted to?

"I hate regressors."

Jaehwan, sitting on the floating stone and cleaning his sword, opened his mouth.

"I hate those who don't try. I hate the rotten spirit that gives up on life without even fighting to the end."

It's been a while since I felt like I was going to be cut by words. Quiet and refined anger.

Jaehwan held back his anger and looked at me, then at Yoo Joonghyuk.

"He's a strange guy. He really attacked me with the intention of killing me. He knew he was no match for me, but he used all his strength to attack me again and again."

I thought of Yoo Joonghyuk, who was rushing at me like an animal while activating story fragments.

He told me that this was his last round. He said he would never be able to regress again.

Even so, he risked his life and faced Jaehwan.

"There must be a reason why he has to save you."

I knew it the moment I saw Jaehwan's face. Jaehwan wasn't talking about me or Yoo Joonghyuk right now.

I recalled his history. The sentences that Kiyeon had written. It seemed like old events were coming back to life in my head along with Jaehwan's voice.

"I had a comrade."

Before Jaehwan was called the 'Monarch Slayer'. It was when he was climbing the terrible tower called the 'Tower of Nightmare'.

On the last floor of that tower, he lost his old comrade.

"The guy was injured beyond recovery."

Before the last floor of the tower, Jaehwan's only comrade leaned against the window and looked at the sky.

Only Jaehwan would walk to the next floor.

He slowly put his hand into his bosom, imagining the next and the next floor.

"In my world, there is an item called the 'Regression Stone'."

The Regression Stone.

"It was an item that sent the user back to the past."

I also knew about the existence of that item. Jaehwan's colleagues also used that item and abandoned the world.

"My colleague who was about to die took out the stone from his bosom, knowing how much I hated that stone."

"And?"

"He said he was sorry that we couldn't go to the next floor together."

"What did you say?"

"I told him to get out right away."

I smiled bitterly.

"But was it really necessary to say that? You said he was a precious colleague."

"The stone he took out wasn't the 'Regression Stone'."

His colleague made a choice. To touch Jaehwan's sore spot in order to ease his guilt.

To risk his life to open the path to becoming the 'Monarch Slayer'.

"You believed your friend's lies."

Jaehwan didn't answer and stared into the air again.

I looked at him. Before, I had no idea what he was looking at, but now I think I have some idea of what kind of scenery he was looking at in the void.

"Sometimes I think about that. What if I had somehow saved that guy instead of climbing the tower?"

All humans constantly regress to the past. They regret the choices they didn't make. It was the same for Yoo Joonghyuk and the Monarch Slayer.

I looked down at the sleeping little Yoo Joonghyuk.

It was ironic. Yoo Joonghyuk, the 41st Round, had been hated by the 'Disaster of Floods' for using his comrades like consumables.

That Yoo Joonghyuk had found favor with the Monarch Slayer for protecting his comrades.

Jaehwan continued to speak.

"I owe a debt to that guy called 'Yoo Joonghyuk.'"

"You mean this guy?"

"No, to the guy named Yoo Joonghyuk from another 'worldline'.

I blinked my eyes blankly and then suddenly came to my senses.

"No way—"

Scenarios came to mind.

Washington Dome. The shaking Void Curtain.

At that time, the 'Demon King of Salvation' said, Yoo Joonghyuk is beyond that Void Curtain.

The Yoo Joonghyuk from <Kim Dokja Company> that we remember.

"Where is that Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"I don't know either. He went crazy like a madman and fought the Constellations and disappeared."

"Ah…"

"He brought me all the way here and then disappeared on his own."

Huh?

"The worldview is different, so my abilities don't manifest properly here. If it weren't for that bastard, I wouldn't be in such a faraway place."

"Were you lost and wandering around?"

Jaehwan didn't say anything for a moment.

"I didn't say anything like that."

There is no such thing as a lost person.

"I know. Everyone is confused when they first come to a place."

Maybe this is an opportunity given by Yoo Joonghyuk?

"Is there a place you want to go? You probably want to meet strong guys, right? It'll take some time, but if that's the case, leave it to me. I'll show you around."

"You've completely lost my trust."

"But I'm the one who knows the <Star Stream> better than anyone else?"

It was true. In this world, the only one who knows the <Star Stream> better than me is Kim Dokja.

And now, that Kim Dokja is me.

"Where do you want to see? <Olympus>? <Asgard>? Ah, do you want to experience Journey to the West?"

I talked as best I could, but I really couldn't take Jaehwan there. Even if it was Jaehwan, he couldn't protect us in the context of the Constellations where Mythical-grade Constellations were flying around.

I wanted to chase after this guy with Yoo Joonghyuk and destroy all of the <Star Stream>, but probability didn't work that way.

However, I thought that this meeting might be a chance for Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round. Yoo Joonghyuk who no longer returns.

What if the 'Monarch Slayer' who hates regression teaches Yoo Joonghyuk?

If that's possible, maybe I'll be able to see Yoo Joonghyuk, the strongest in the world, in this Round.

It was then that Jaehwan's expression changed as he listened to me. Jaehwan slowly moved his hand to the handle of his sword and began to radiate a scary aura.

I sighed and took a step back without realizing it.

Damn it, should I have just shut up and stayed still?

Then came the sound of thunder from afar. Jaehwan laughed coldly amidst the loud noise that seemed to split the entire universe in half. Only then did I feel something was wrong.

"It seems the guest you were talking about has finally arrived."

When I suddenly turned my head, a dazzling legion of Constellations was approaching from the distant void.

It was the eleventh day since I met Jaehwan, the Monarch Slayer.

<Eden> came to see us.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 800 Episode 38 Chance (6)

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A splendid army of seraphs illuminated the darkness. The seraphs of <Eden>, each of which was as strong as a Historical-grade Constellation, and the Archangels of <Eden> who commanded them, revealed their outlines in the void.

As expected, most of them were Archangels I knew.

[The Constellation 'Lily pin of Aquarius' looks at you.]

Archangel Gabriel.

[The Constellation 'Guardian of Youth and Travel' looks at you.]

Archangel Raphael.

[The Constellation 'Friend of Justice and Harmony' takes pity on you.]

[The Constellation 'He who looks face to face with God' looks at you.]

Archangel Raguel and Camael.

[The Constellation 'Commander of the Red Cosmos' is looking at you.]

Killer King's sponsor, Archangel Jophiel.

[The Constellation 'Savior of the Fall' is looking at you.]

Even Michael, the strongest Archangel.

I calmed my pounding heart and checked the faces of the Archangels again and again.

Uriel is gone.

A belated worry came over me.

Maybe she had tried too hard to save me last time. Or maybe I had received some kind of threat from <Eden>.

「Come to your senses.」

As if it was not the time to worry about Uriel, the Demon King of Salvation warned through the [Fourth Wall]. I swallowed and nodded.

The fact that I could endure facing such magnificent Archangels was all thanks to the naked (clothed) man blocking my way.

The Monarch Slayer Jaehwan.

I realized once again how great he was. Even if you search through the entire <Star Stream>, it would be difficult to find a Constellation that wouldn't be intimidated by a single Giant Nebula.

Even that figure calmly reaching for the hilt of his sword as if such a threat was ridiculous…

"Wait a minute!"

"What is it?"

Jaehwan glared at me with a sharp gaze. I belatedly regretted it.

Now that I think about it, why did I do that?

Why did I stop Jaehwan?

"They might not have come to fight."

That's right. That was my reason.

While I was with the 'Demon King of Salvation', I was chased by Giant Nebulas several times.

<Asgard> and <Olympus>. Or small Nebulas like <Gwiok>.

But I've never been chased by <Eden>.

"Let's talk about it first."

"Why should I?"

By the way, Jaehwan, the 'Monarch Slayer', has another nickname, 'God Slayer'.

"There's no need to hurt someone who doesn't have any hostility."

"That guy Yoo Joonghyuk told me. He said that there are no harmless Constellations in the world."

Joonghyuk, what on earth did he say?

"No, Constellations aren't generally harmful."

I don't know why I'm defending the Constellations.

But this was the only way to prevent a catastrophe. If there was Uriel among them that I hadn't discovered, it would be a big deal.

I took a deep breath and spoke in one breath.

"That's Yoo Joonghyuk's standard, and yours is different. Look at those fluttering pure white wings. Do they look like bad Constellations to you?"

Jaehwan glanced at the Archangels again at my words. Maybe the Monarch Slayer was a pretty sensible person.

At that moment, one of the Archangels who caught my eye stepped forward. He was the Archangel who shouldn't have stepped forward the most.

[You are the 'Monarch Slayer'—]

I stepped in front of Jaehwan before Archangel Stab was activated.

"Over there! Wait a minute! Over there!"

[...?]

"Savior of the Corrupted! Don't finish that sentence now!"

Michael glared at me as I stepped in front of Jaehwan and opened my mouth again.

[What are you?]

Michael, the Savior of the Corrupted, is a Constellation of the Tale of the Fall. He's not even a simple Tale of the Fall, he's an Archangel who can reach the level of a Myth-grade when he activates 'Demon King'. There's probably only one incarnation in the entire <Star Stream> who can tease an Archangel like that.

"Me? I'm Kim Dokja."

Damn it, why am I Kim Dokja?

Michael, who had been glaring at me, asked back in a stupid voice.

[So?]

"Let's all get along well."

An eerie silence swept over the surroundings. I heard Raphael's sighing voice, and I also saw Gabriel shaking his head with his hand on his head. Jophiel stared at me as if he was looking at a strange creature.

And then,

Kugugugugu!

Michael began to unleash his power without hesitation.

[The Constellation 'Savior of the Fall' reveals his status.]

I hid behind Jaehwan again while watching Michael approaching step by step.

Honestly, why wouldn't I want to see it?

Michael vs. Jaehwan.

Savior of the Corrupted vs. Monarch Slayer.

Especially, if it was Michael and Jaehwan who activated 'Demon King', it would be a spectacle that I wouldn't be able to see even if I paid a thousand gold coins.

However, that's something 'rlaehrwk41' would think about, and it wasn't something I would be thinking about right now.

If a great clash of Myth-grade Constellations occurred right before my eyes, Yoo Joonghyuk and I would be swept away by the fierce waves of the stories and our limbs would be torn apart.

"Hey, Jaehwan-ssi. Actually, this is a bad guy. Could you kill just one of them?"

While Jaehwan was looking back at me as if he was dumbfounded, the other Archangels were approaching Michael.

I shouted in a hurry.

"Wait a minute! Stop! You know how scary this guy is!"

Thankfully, the Archangels had heard rumors of Jaehwan and were not acting rashly.

I quickly added.

"And this guy is not an evil person! He rejects evil and worships good! Isn't that the motto of your <Eden>? Never judge by appearances! He's even dressed so neatly!"

"You bastard."

I ignored Jaehwan's growling words and continued to shout.

"This person saved me and Yoo Joonghyuk. He saved us from the terrible Constellations of <Olympus> and <Asgard>— from the Gods of the Outer World!"

Jaehwan's sword, which was half-drawn, stopped for the first time. It felt like he was trying to hear what I was saying.

"This person also patted my back when I swallowed story fragments. It hurt so much that I could die, but I survived, so I guess I received the grace of life."

"..."

"Is that all? He stabbed and killed every Outer God who came near him for a whole ten days. Where else would you find someone who would show me such kindness while the

Giant Nebulae were after me? Yes?"

When I came to my senses, I found myself repeating the argument of the 'Demon King of Salvation' like a parrot. But as I spoke, it seemed like he was right.

A murderer of Monarchs is not a villain. At least to me and Yoo Joonghyuk.

However, Archangel Jophiel seemed to have a slightly different opinion.

[He is evil.]

An ominous light was flowing out of Jophiel's eyes. His stigma, [Eye of Sin], had been activated.

When Jaehwan glared at him as if asking what was that, the light of [Eye of Sin] went out with a tsk-tsk sound. It seemed that an absolute being from another universe could extinguish a stigma just by glaring at it.

But even in that situation, Jophiel seemed to have witnessed something.

I struck first before he could open his mouth.

"Yes. Of course, it could be different depending on the perspective—"

[He slaughtered over a million gods.]

I looked back at Jaehwan.

This kid is a villain, right?

But I pretended to be calm and responded.

"Couldn't all the gods he killed be bad guys? He must have done it with good intentions. Right? He must have tried to make the world a better place—"

"My goal was to destroy the world."

"Yes, so to put it simply, in order to kill the evil gods and purify the world—"

"I killed them because they got in my way."

I wanted to tell him to shut up, but since ancient times, protagonists have never shut up when told to.

In the meantime, another protagonist who had come to his senses spoke to me.

—Kim Dokja.

Little Yoo Joonghyuk was getting up from the floating stone. He seemed to have figured out the general situation.

Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth to the Archangels, receiving my gaze that told him to stop them somehow.

"I want to kill them all."

Jaehwan nodded and muttered at Yoo Joonghyuk's words.

"There are times when we can see eye to eye."

The situation was becoming increasingly chaotic.

The moment I thought that this wouldn't be easy to solve even if the Demon King of Salvation came in person, Jaehwan's expression changed for the first time.

"This is fun."

The word 'fun' sounded different after meeting him.

I followed Jaehwan's gaze, hiding my ominous feelings. Then, the line of seraphs split, and an Archangel was seen walking from the back.

The Mythical Constellation of <Eden> was there.

The Ruler of the Archangels, and the second-in-command of <Eden>.

[The Constellation 'Heavenly Scribe' is looking at you.]

Heavenly Scribe, Metatron.

Who would have thought I would see him here?

I bit my lips without realizing it. The fact that he was here in person meant that <Eden> was serious about this situation.

[It's nice to meet you.]

A uniquely polite and calm voice.

The first place his eyes turned to was little Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The Puppet of the Oldest Dream.]

Then he looked at Jaehwan.

[The Monarch Slayer.]

Finally, he stared at me.

[And...]

He looked at me for a long time, then continued speaking with a faint sense of pride.

[Little lamb. You're afraid.]

Of course. My sponsor would be scared if legions of Archangels came rushing in. What's more, if the opponent was 'Metatron', the master of strategy that even Kim Dokja would shiver with…

[Don't worry. <Eden> and I will not harm you. We have no intention of changing the contents of the 'Revelation'.]

I immediately revised my evaluation of Metatron in my head.

What kind of place is <Eden>? It is a Nebula of angels. Angels are generally kind. If he is the representative of such angels, then he must be the kindest angel of all.

I briefly hoped that he might mediate all of this.

[However, I cannot tolerate beings who break the balance of this world line.]

It was a vain hope.

The moment Metatron and Jaehwan's gazes crossed, Jaehwan pulled out his sword with a bitter smile.

"Your tongue is long. If you are going to attack, attack quickly."

The Archangels who were guarding Metatron quietly raised their voices at his arrogant tone.

Nevertheless, Jaehwan continued to speak as if provoking them.

“Do you think you can stop me with just a single person?”

The strength to fight a Giant Nebula alone.

Metatron acknowledged Jaehwan like that.

He nodded.

[Absolute being of another world line. I know you are strong. If we were to eliminate you, we would not be safe either.]

"You will all die here."

Metatron shrugged lightly and smiled bitterly.

[I guess you forgot that this is not your 'worldview'.]

That was when I felt an unusual magical power behind us. A being with the exact opposite attribute of the Archangels.

There were beings that should not be there.

[The Demon King 'Lord of Hell' descends into the void!]

[The Demon King 'Sonic Demon King' descends into the void!]

[The Demon King 'Temptation and Barren Demon King' descends into the void!]

[The Demon King 'Merciless Hunter of the Reverse Heaven' descends into the void!]

…

[The Demon King 'Ruler of Eastern Hell' descends into the void!]

Demon Kings. It was unbelievable.

Why on earth did they show up here?

They wouldn't be trying to start a holy war here.

Hold on. Holy war?

"Run away. Right now."

Jaehwan glared at me as if I was talking nonsense.

"Are you talking about me just now?"

"That's right! Run away with me and Yoo Joonghyuk! Right now!"

I don't think Jaehwan will lose. Even if it's a Myth-grade Constellation, even if it's the famous <Eden>, it wouldn't be easy to deal with Jaehwan.

「But if it's 'sealing' him, it might be a different story.」

Two pitch-black swirling spheres were placed in Metatron's hands. I already knew what those spheres were.

[Get out of this story. Ghost of a ruined universe.]

That was a forbidden technique that Han Sooyoung once used to seal 'Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,863rd Round.'

[Mythical tale 'Seal of the Apocalypse' begins its storytelling!]

As long as this is the <Star Stream>, there is no one who can break that seal.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 801 Episode 38 Chance (7)

"A seal."

Listening to Jaehwan's indifferent voice, a sense of anticipation suddenly rose.

What if Jaehwan, the strongest of the 《Tree of Imaginary》, could break that sealing ball of the Apocalypse Dragon?

"Do you think you can trap me with something like that?"

Jaehwan was confident. As if he was certain that no world could trap him.

Metatron nodded.

[It might be difficult to trap you forever. This 'sealing sphere' didn't borrow the full probability of the Holy Demon War.]

That was right. Unless the 'Holy Demon War' breaks out right now, the story of that 'sealing sphere' won't be able to display its original power of sealing the 'Apocalypse Dragon.'

[However, you're not as strong as you were in your world.]

"I still have the power to wipe out the likes of you."

[Well, even so, I don’t know if you’ll have anything left to protect when you escape from this sealed area.]

Only then did I realize what Metatron was after.

An ominous thought ran through my head. What if Jaehwan escaped from the sealed area and the Constellations had already defeated Yoo Joonghyuk and me?

Looking at Metatron, who was smiling eerily, I whispered to Jaehwan.

"Jaehwan-ssi, let’s just kill those two, including that Michael, and leave. Can you do that? I’ll buy you a hundred Murim dumplings."

This time, I wanted to see Jaehwan looking back at me with a bewildered expression and stabbing those guys coolly.

However, Jaehwan’s expression when he looked back at me wasn’t that bright.

When did it start? A faint spark was flowing through Jaehwan’s entire body. It wasn’t probability.

[The <Star Stream> is staring at 'Jaehwan'.]

The world he didn't belong to was squeezing his body more and more tightly.

As if he noticed that, Metatron gently soothed him.

[This world is not your playground.]

"…"

[I don't know why you came here, but the world you lived in has been destroyed. And your story has ended.]

Jaehwan raised his head without saying anything. His eyes stared into the void once again.

I thought I knew what he was reminiscing about. That was why I couldn't intervene in his return.

That memory was his alone. Now, no one but him would be able to share that world's memories.

"I know. My world is already over."

Perhaps he finally felt like he could communicate. Metatron's momentum as he summoned the sealing sphere weakened.

[Let's do this. If you go back right now, I won't use this 'sealing sphere'.]

A heavy silence swept over the surroundings once again. I slowly retreated to the side of little Yoo Joonghyuk, ready to run away at any moment.

To be honest, Jaehwan had no reason to protect us anymore. In the first place, the fact that he had protected us until now was a strangely excessive favor.

Jaehwan, who had been thinking for a moment, opened his mouth again.

"My world is over, but I am not over."

Metatron tilted his head as if he was guessing what that meant and replied.

[Even if that were true, it doesn't seem like something I should hear in a place like this. Again, this is not your world.]

"Of course, you are not my 'world'."

Jaehwan looked back at me.

"But these guys are different."

The moment I met those indifferent eyes, something welled up in me without me knowing.

I knew it instinctively.

「This will probably be a debt I can never repay.」

Metatron opened his mouth urgently, perhaps sensing something ominous.

[They are also beings of this 'world'! You have no justification to interfere with the stories of this world! You—]

"I don't need a justification."

Before I could say anything, a pitch-black light began to condense from Jaehwan's sword. It was a stabbing stance.

No, wait. But why are you looking at us?

Jaehwan then turned to little Yoo Joonghyuk and said.

"That pale guy said that if you regress 1,863 times, you can become stronger than me."

"What are you trying to say?"

"If it's something that can be done only by regressing 1,863 times, then you can do it without regressing any more."

"What—"

Jaehwan's blade spurted fire.

Stabs poured down on us.

I instinctively grabbed little Yoo Joonghyuk by the back of his neck.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

The stabs that seemed like they would destroy us at any moment unexpectedly wrapped us gently and shot off into the distance. As if we had boarded a rocket, the surrounding scenery quickly became distant. From a distant location, Constellations were seen shouting at us.

[The Demon King 'Demon King of Sound' glares!]

[The Demon King 'Merciless Hunter of the Reverse Sky' is chasing after you!]

…

[The Constellation 'Guardian of Youth and Travel' looks at you.]

[The Constellation 'Lily of Aquarius' shows a relieved expression.]

Before we could even say our final greetings, Jaehwan's figure disappeared into a small dot in an instant.

Following that, a bright light burst out from afar. The fight had finally begun.

Will it be okay? Even so, could he deal with the Archangels and Demon Kings using the 'Sealing Orb' while bearing the probability penalty of the <Star Stream>?

"This is not the time to worry about others."

Yoo Joonghyuk was right.

Jaehwan's stabs were pushing us back with incredible force, but there were still enemies targeting us from all sides. The Constellations of the small and Medium Nebulae were waiting for us at the outskirts of the galaxy, avoiding Jaehwan.

[Chase them!]

[What speed—]

Fortunately, Jaehwan's thrusts were much faster than the Constellations were chasing us. It seemed to be accelerating even more.

I said while carrying little Yoo Joonghyuk on my back.

"Hold on tight."

The galaxy's scenery was passing by so fast that it was breathtaking. It was probably a scenery I would never see again.

I asked little Yoo Joonghyuk, who was shaking slightly on my back, while holding him so he wouldn't be thrown away.

"How many story imprints did you use?"

Yoo Joonghyuk's difficulty was a side effect of the 'story imprint'.

However, as he gradually got used to the side effect, I hadn't seen him as a kid recently. However, the fact that he was a kid meant that he had expended a great deal of mental energy fighting Jaehwan.

"All three."

"Are you in your right mind?"

In this round, Yoo Joonghyuk carved a total of three imprints on himself.

「Binding of Truth」

「Binding of Emotions」

「Binding of Life」

I had seen the first two used before, but I had never heard of him using the third imprint.

That was because 「Binding of Life」 was literally a legend imprint that cost one's life.

Yoo Joonghyuk shook his head calmly and said.

"Not a problem. The 'life' of the third story imprint can be divided and used."

"No, can you have multiple lives?"

"It means that the lifespan can be divided and used."

Ah, so the price is calculated by lifespan.

It seems that 「Binding of Life」 has a similar price to Yoo Joonghyuk's special trait in the 0th Round, 'Life of Power'.

"How many years have you used?"

"It's none of your business."

"No, it is, so tell me quickly. It would be a problem if you fought hard and then suddenly died."

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't answer.

After a little more time passed, I heard a soft breathing sound from my back.

I was a little taken aback.

"Are you asleep?"

"..."

"Listen."

Maybe it was because he was still a kid.

He must have decided that he should sleep a little longer in order to recover quickly.

Thinking that he really was a strong-willed guy, I muttered in a small voice.

"Get some sleep."

No matter how many years of life he sacrificed, the reason he used the imprint was to protect me.

Even if it was ultimately to achieve his own goal, it was never easy to risk your life for someone else. Especially if that person was 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.

Anyway, looking back, I suddenly felt regretful. I missed the scene where the two main characters with different worldviews fought. If I had come to my senses, I might have been able to write a better sentence. I imagined the two protagonists swinging their swords at each other, then looked back at the direction Jaehwan was in.

「Kim Dokja thought it was as if he was riding on Jaehwan's back.」

Despite so many things that had happened, the darkness of the <Star Stream> remained firmly silent as if nothing had happened.

「I must become strong enough to navigate this universe on my own.」

As if only Jaehwan's proud stab proved that he was still alive, he carried us and drifted somewhere leisurely.

「So that when we meet again next time, this moment won't be embarrassing.」

---

Damn, that was a good moment.

[A Giant Nebula is looking for you!]

The message in my ear woke me up.

Judging by something wriggling on my back, it seemed that Yoo Joonghyuk had also come to his senses.

"Kim Dokja. Come to your senses."

I looked around hurriedly, and I saw Constellations approaching us from a very far away place.

There was no one left to protect us anymore. If we encounter <Asgard> or <Olympus> here, this time it’s really over.

"It’s weaker than before."

To make matters worse, the momentum of the stab that sent us flying has also weakened.

What happened to Jaehwan?

There was nothing we could know at the moment.

"It doesn’t matter. It’s about time we came to 'that area'."

Is it because of my mood? Since he met Jaehwan, Yoo Joonghyuk also felt strangely changed.

It seemed as if he had made up his mind about something.

"Do you know where this is?"

"I know."

Since when did he activate [Sage’s Eyes]? Little Yoo Joonghyuk rolled his golden eyes and opened his mouth again.

"We’ll be there soon."

As soon as I heard Yoo Joonghyuk’s words, the Constellations that had discovered us from afar began to rush in.

[Catch him.]

<Olympus> and <Asgard> are visible. There were Historical-grade Constellations and Narrative-grade Constellations. I suddenly realized that there were too many Constellations in the <Star Stream>.

"Get off here."

At the signal from Yoo Joonghyuk, we escaped Jaehwan's stab. Then, I felt the gravity of the story pulling us towards it.

[Chase Him! You absolutely must not miss—]

The Narrative-grade Constellations that emitted a terrifying air current were on the rise.

A single weapon that flew through the air grazed my cheek.

Meanwhile, I and Yoo Joonghyuk continued to fall towards the scenario area.

Then, a soft curtain-like thing enveloped us.

'Void Curtain.'

The probability of the <Star Stream> protecting the scenario area was activated.

The Constellations chasing us stopped as if they were angry. They, who were radiating their original power, could not enter the Void Curtain.

Then, what about us?

[The <Star Stream> is looking at you.]

For a moment, I felt the gaze of the distant universe looking at me.

Fortunately, the curtain did not block us.

The next moment, I felt the world turn upside down.

[You have entered a new 'Scenario Area'!]

[You are an 'Exile'.]

[Acquire a new 'Scenario' and participate in the scenario!]

[If you fail to acquire the 'Scenario', the speed of the incarnation body's collapse will accelerate!]

A much greater backlash than before surged into the incarnation body. It felt like my stomach was turning inside out.

[The relevant scenario area is...]

I heard some kind of message in my ear, but I couldn't hear it at all.

How long had I been retching like that? I heard little Yoo Joonghyuk's voice.

"Kim Dokja. Get up."

"Just 10 minutes."

"I told you to get up."

"Just 5 minutes. I can't get up because I'm dizzy."

"Overcome it with your mental strength."

"No, there are things you can do and things you can't do."

I cursed inwardly and got up. As I looked around while staggering, I saw a pile of rice in a corner.

The place where we fell was a barn.

And before my eyes was little Yoo Joonghyuk glaring at me with a sharp gaze.

"You said you were going to see the 'end of the world' with that much determination?"

"..."

"Why are you laughing?"

Of course, little Yoo Joonghyuk with a rag on his lips was talking desperately. I opened my mouth, feeling like I could write a short story called 「Little Yoo Joonghyuk at the End of the World」 right away if I had a keyboard.

"Where is this place?"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me with pitiful eyes and opened his mouth.

"Maybe."

Yoo Joonghyuk doesn’t use the expression 'maybe' often in the story.

Nevertheless, the fact that he used it must mean that we were in a difficult situation.

It means that Yoo Joonghyuk, who prefers certain options, was pushed to the point where he had no choice but to rely on expectations.

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk’s follow-up words weren’t so bad, to be honest.

"The place where the only person who can help us is."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 802 Episode 39 Rumor (1)

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[Story Fragment 'Daytime Talk is Heard by Birds' continues its storytelling.]

Story Fragment 'Daytime Talk is Heard by Birds' picked up at the Recycling Center.

This fragment, which has a relatively low probability cost, was literally perfect for eavesdropping on other incarnations' conversations during the 'daytime'.

"Who's coming as a judge for this year's festival?"

"Namgung Sega."

"Oh, the proud Sega-ju have finally made a move."

[NOTE 1]

"What's the point of making a move? The winner will be..."

Everything said within a 100-meter radius sounded like someone was whispering right next to them.

"For sale! ... Dumplings for sale!"

"We also have hot chicken soup!"

Is it because I'm still not used to using Story Fragments?

"Have you heard the news?"

"I heard it. The story that <Twelve Zodiac Signs> were destroyed."

"... Fragments... "

Some conversations were audible, and some were not.

"By the way, next week is already the 'Guardian Dragon Expedition'. Which sect will participate this time?"

"So the martial arts competition this year was canceled? I think the focus will be on the expedition team..."

Still, this was enough keywords to judge the situation.

Namgung Sega. Dumplings. Chicken soup. Martial arts competition. And Guardian Dragon Expedition.

When I nodded, Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been silently glaring at me, said a word.

"You're a suspicious guy."

"Please say that I have a cautious personality. This is truly the 'First Murim'."

'First Murim.'

I have come to the 'First Murim,' the holy land of martial arts that I had only heard of.

[The 30th Main Scenario' is currently in progress in the relevant scenario area.]

The 30th Main Scenario.

Considering that the 'First Murim' is originally a place where people who perform various scenarios from the 20th to the 40th gather, it would not be strange if the 30th Main Scenario was in progress.

Tsutsutsut.

Not only me, but Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body was also filled with small sparks. It must have been a penalty for scenario jumping.

In fact, my body felt a little heavy and the air was stuffy since a while ago. Could this be the density of the 'story' of the 30th Scenario?

Still, my body quickly got used to it, perhaps because of the level I had built up.

[Acquire a new scenario.]

[Your incarnation body is weakening.]

Collapse in real time except for sending me a teaser trailer.

I tried hard not to show it and smiled.

"I think I know who you came to see."

Now, Yoo Joonghyuk answered with narrowed eyes, as if he wasn't surprised that I knew something.

"I didn't plan on meeting them this time, but."

'First Murim' was where Yoo Joonghyuk's master, Breaking the Sky Swords Saint, was.

Breaking the Sky Swords Saint, one of the strongest Transcendents.

Yoo Joonghyuk probably wanted to get her on our side, just like he did in the main story.

"What you need now is 'recovery of the incarnation body' and 'acquisition of a new scenario'."

"That's right. How did you know?"

"Because I've been expelled before. Maybe I can get help."

Honestly, I was surprised. Even if his purpose was to use me, Yoo Joonghyuk is this kind? Did he get stabbed by Jaehwan-ssi so much that he went crazy?

In any case, it was fortunate for me now.

I quickly got up and said before Yoo Joonghyuk could come to his senses.

"Okay. Let's go right away."

"..."

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at me with his characteristically troubled expression.

"Why are you doing that? Please guide me to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint-nim quickly."

"It's unfortunate."

It was only then that I realized what had happened to Yoo Joonghyuk.

One of the side effects of 'Story Imprint' is memory loss. Especially if he uses too much force to the point where he's turning into a little person like he is now, he'll temporarily lose unwanted memories.

In other words.

"That's right... You've forgotten all the memories you need."

Until Yoo Joonghyuk recovers his original incarnation, we won't be able to find Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's residence.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me with shameless eyes.

"You should find it yourself."

"How can I find it? This is my first time in the 'First Murim'. I don't even know where this is."

I've fallen into the 'First Murim' and lost my way. To make matters worse, Yoo Joonghyuk is a useless kid with amnesia, and I have an incarnation body that I won't find strange to die in an hour.

Damn, even 'Starting a Murim Life from Zero' would be better than this.

I looked at our beggarly appearances and said.

"Shall we go into the Beggar Sect?"

"…"

"I'll go around begging for food in the Beggar Sect and asking people. Hey, where is Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's house?"

Deciding to ignore my words, Yoo Joonghyuk looked into the distance and thought.

Kkottuk.

To make matters worse, a sound came from inside his stomach.

We looked at each other.

"First of all, it’s not me."

"Me neither."

We decided to take care of our hunger first.

Fortunately, this was the 'First Martial Arts World'. There was food that Yoo Joonghyuk, who was picky about food, could buy and eat.

Come to think of it, did Jaehwan-ssi send us to a place with 'Murim Dumplings' on purpose?

"There’s a place nearby that sells Murim dumplings. But it’s better than when we were at the Recycling Center."

As I stood up, shaking off the rags, Yoo Joonghyuk unexpectedly stopped me.

"Are you going to go like that?"

"What. If you are dissatisfied, buy it yourself."

"Okay."

"Huh?"

Surprisingly, Yoo Joonghyuk got up from his seat obediently. I don't know how many times I was surprised today.

"This is the regular scenario area. Do you know what kind of person an exile who wanders around during the day without a scenario will end up like?"

I forgot for a moment.

The people of Murim are those who thirst for enlightenment more than anyone else. They are those who would buy enlightenment even if it meant paying coins in order to advance their martial arts skills.

And the easiest way to gain enlightenment in this Star Stream is to use 'stories'.

If an exile who keeps dripping stories appears in the meantime, it was clear what kind of fate he would face.

"If you're lucky, you might be taken to the government office and survive, but—"

"If that happens, I'll be sold to the Management Bureau and become a servant of the scenario."

"Is that what you want to be?"

I shrugged.

Yoo Joonghyuk came towards me without saying anything and suddenly held out his hand.

"You're asking for coins, aren't you?"

Damn, what a meticulous bastard. A bastard who wouldn't even buy a single Murim dumpling with his own money.

I thought that this place had chicken soup with Murim dumplings, and other things. I gave him coins so he could buy enough snacks.

Yoo Joonghyuk counted the coins I gave him and nodded his head in satisfaction.

"You're not going to run away just like that, are you?"

"..."

"Do you know where the Murim dumplings are?"

Was I being too nitpicky?

Yoo Joonghyuk looked back at me in anger and said.

"I think you forgot."

Then that's right.

I sighed deeply and said.

"Let's just go together."

"But you—"

"This is how it's done."

I transformed my 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' into 'Ever-Changing Transformations Suit'. Then, I used the Suit to transform my body size.

['Ever-Changing Transformations Suit' has reached its limit of change.]

[You can't get any smaller.]

I shrunk to the size of a dwarf in Peace Land and hid in Yoo Joonghyuk's coat pocket.

Yoo Joonghyuk narrowed his eyes as if he was impressed. He said.

"You've only learned strange tricks."

"That's not something I want to hear from a child who can't even live alone."

As he opened the barn door while grumbling, the streets of the 'First Murim' unfolded right away. Several vendors seemed to be looking our way, but their gazes quickly dispersed.

I used 'Midday Tryst' to talk to Yoo Joonghyuk and looked around the streets.

—When will your body recover?

"It'll take four days."

—Buy lots of Murim dumplings. You eat eight meals a day, right?

"That's not always the case."

I thought to myself that it was fortunate that this was Murim. At least there were foods here that Yoo Joonghyuk, who was picky about food, could eat 'eight meals'.

—Over there.

I guided Yoo Joonghyuk to the street corner where I had heard the sound of dumplings being sold. How long had we walked? I thought I smelled something delicious from afar, and then I saw a row of old street stalls.

[The 'Murim Dumpling Festival' is currently in progress.]

No, there was an event like this?

Yoo Joonghyuk was also quite surprised, as if it was his first time in this situation.

The signs of street vendors on every street all had 'Murim Dumplings' written on them.

「Original Murim Dumplings」

「Real Original Murim Dumplings」

「Original Murim Dumpling Omakase」

「Genuine Murim Dumplings Approved by Dokkaebis」

「New Original Murim Dumplings」

「Grandma's Murim Dumplings」

「Black and White Murim Dumplings」

...

How many 'Original Murim Dumplings' are there?

—What's the real deal? No, damn it. You said you forgot.

Instead of responding to my grumbling, Yoo Joonghyuk was staring at the dumpling alley with a blank look in his eyes.

That made sense. 'Murim Dumplings' are a food that holds great meaning to him, too. Maybe he was thinking of the story with Breaking the Sky Saint. A warm dumpling that his teacher Breaking the Sky Sword Saint bought on his birthday.

There are moments that even a Regressor cannot return to. And right now, Yoo Joonghyuk must have returned to that moment that he can never return to.

Gulp.

Maybe he just got hungry and turned into a frozen fish.

—Let’s eat quickly. Where should I buy some?

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly started looking around the nearby stores at my urging. Since it was the dumpling festival, there were events related to Murim dumplings going on everywhere.

Among them, two things stood out.

[The 'Murim Dumpling Eating Competition' is currently in progress.]

If there were any good prizes, it would be a competition worth participating in.

Above all, we have the story 'Pig that Eats Eight Meals'.

[The 'Best Murim Dumpling Competition' is currently in progress.]

However, Yoo Joonghyuk was more interested in the 'Best Murim Dumpling Competition'. It occurred to me later that Yoo Joonghyuk was quite the gourmet.

「The legendary dumplings that even the famous gourmets of the <Star Stream>, the Wenny-men, gave 'three humps' to.」

「'Namgung Murim Dumplings', try them now.」

'Namgung Murim Dumplings.'

Was it because of the name of the dumplings? Yoo Joonghyuk's steps slowly moved in that direction.

The dumpling restaurant was bustling from the entrance.

It seemed that the judges of the competition had just visited the dumpling restaurant.

"Now, judges, come and try it!"

The owner brought out a bowl full of dumplings with a gesture. Judging from the glossy sheen flowing from the soft dumpling skin, they seemed to be well-made.

Yoo Joonghyuk said.

"Franchise dumplings."

—Huh? Do Murim dumplings have a franchise?

In fact, next to the store, they were selling dumplings in boxes and making a killing.

Just as I was thinking that something strange was going on, the head of the judging committee in question stepped forward and picked up a dumpling.

"You can tell just by looking at it."

A middle-aged man with a stern face.

The moment he opened his mouth, cheers could be heard from the surroundings.

"Namgung Jincheon!"

"It's the Emperor's Sword!"

The Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon.

I knew that name too.

He was the head of the Five Great Families that ruled the 'First Murim' and one of the top ten masters of the current 'First Murim'.

He slowly ate the Murim dumplings. Namgung Jincheon took a big bite of the dumpling.

He calmly chewed the dumpling, then opened his mouth with a warm smile.

"What a great dumpling."

Wow, the cheers poured out.

Only then did I realize how this dumpling competition was going.

—No, these people don't seem to have any intention of hiding anything.

The name of the dumpling is 'Namgung Murim Dumpling', and 'Namgung Jincheon' is listed as a judge.

—The martial arts world has really become corrupted.

Come to think of it, the 'First Murim' has been completely capitalized by the dokkaebis. There was no way an honest 'contest' could exist.

In other words, this 'contest' was nothing more than a festival disguised to promote the 'Namgung Murim Dumpling' from the beginning.

Now, the 'Murim Dumpling' is being packaged as 'Murim Dumpling Approved by the Namgung Family' and is selling like hotcakes in the Dokkaebi bag. Let's go.

"Our Respectable Master really liked Murim dumplings. I really hope you try these dumplings."

The surrounding warriors cheered once again at Namgung Jincheon's words.

"I will announce this in the name of the Namgung Sega Family. The winner of this year's 'Dumpling Contest' is—"

Emperor's Sword, Namgung Jincheon.

He is a figure who, at least in this 'Murim', exercises power comparable to that of the <Olympus> 12 constellations.

There was no one here who could dare to go against his judgment.

Except for one person.

"The filling of the dumplings is not evenly cooked."

Namgung Jincheon looked around with wide eyes as the room was covered in a mysterious silence.

There was an inconsiderate brat who spat out the dumplings he had been chewing.

"This is not 'Murim dumplings'."

It was Yoo Joonghyuk.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Sega-ju; it's a title for head of the family. I left it as it is cuz... why not heh.

# 803 Episode 39 Rumor (2)

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During the Murim era when the system had not yet been introduced, the martial artists divided their martial arts proficiency into vague concepts such as '1-star' or '10-star'.

However, the criteria for this 'star' were vague even among the martial artists.

For example, some people said that the section where the sword handle glowed blue was '5-star of Sky-Sovereign Sword Art', while others said that the section where the sword blade glowed blue was '5-star of Sky-Sovereign Sword Art'.

Because of that, if one of the Family's Masters started lying, saying, "I'm 10-star of Sky-Sovereign Sword Art, but since then, the color of the sword has disappeared," it wasn't easy to even debunk that lie.

However, after the system was introduced and the 'New Martial Arts' began, everything changed.

「It became an era where no one could lie about their own realm.」

Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon was a martial artist from the so-called 'New Martial Arts' generation. A generation that was familiar with learning refined martial arts from a young age as [Skills] and evaluating the proficiency of those skills based on their level.

[The skill level of the exclusive skill 'Sky-Sovereign Sword Art' has increased!]

Namgung Jincheon liked his era.

An era where nothing was hidden.

He grew up in an honest martial arts world, a world of clear desires.

「Higher level. Stronger skills.」

That was the only motto of the 'New Martial Arts world'.

Following that motto, he trained martial arts, leveled up, and collected coins.

He cleared the scenarios.

He hunted spirits such as the 'Five Hundred Year Old Weasel', the 'Three Hundred Year Old Toad', and the 'Golden Fur Boar', and even participated in a raid to hunt the 'Giant Imugi'.

However, the stern elders of the martial arts world did not acknowledge his strength.

"The current ones don't know. Do you know how hard it was to learn martial arts in my time?"

"Martial arts are enlightenment. A martial artist without enlightenment cannot become truly strong."

Namgung Jincheon thought.

What the hell is enlightenment? Isn't enlightenment something that is sold in the 'Dokkaebi Bag' anyway? If what you say is true, shouldn't you be stronger than me?

Namgung Jincheon, who was called the Emperor's Sword, became arrogant. He ignored the martial arts world and despised the old elders.

It was like that until it appeared in the martial arts world one day.

「It appeared, tearing through the darkness of the sky.」

The shadow of a giant snake that turned day into night.

【Who messed with my children?】

The martial arts people who heard the incantation died, spitting out blood.

Namgung Jincheon raised his internal energy and desperately resisted the pressure, but instinctively he had a premonition of certain defeat.

「Humans are no match for him.」

Namgung Jincheon immediately asked the Constellations for help.

The followers of 'Namgung Sega' who recognized his talent early on and supported him.

They could solve this situation.

[The Constellation 'Master of Spears' escapes the channel.]

[The Constellation 'Master of Hand-to-Hand Combat' escapes the channel.]

[Many Constellations from the martial arts world escape the channel!]

…

Namgung Jincheon despaired. Even the great Constellations that taught him martial arts were running away from him.

【■Ah■Ah■Ah■Ah■Ah■Ah】

The ten best martial artists of the time were brutally torn apart by the teeth of the Imoogi. The martial artists who were defeated by the Outer God continued to chant the same words like a chant even after their necks were cut off.

Save me. In a landscape where the boundaries of reality were blurred, Namgung Jincheon witnessed a baby Imoogi tearing off the skin of the faces of the martial artists.

The skin of the faces that were torn off soon became the scales of the Imoogi King. Scales made from the skins of hundreds of thousands of humans.

A martial artist who was shaking his shoulders next to him began to mutter.

"Save, save, save, die, save, die, save, die, Imoogi, Imoogi-nim has come. He has come to destroy the martial arts world. He has come to avenge the grudge of the old martial arts world. He has ascended to heaven as a dragon—"

The martial artists around him muttered strange words one by one as if possessed.

Namgung Jincheon desperately raised his magical power to maintain his sanity, but now even that was his limit.

The martial arts world was over. No one could deny that fact.

At that moment, the elder who was bleeding next to him said.

"Jincheon. It's okay. The Sword Master hasn't come yet."

Namgung Jincheon laughed at that.

Sword Master. Was there still someone left in this martial arts world who could be called that?

The Constellations had fled, and the ten greatest masters in the world had died. In this martial arts world where there was nothing left, who on earth was left?

「And then Namgung Jincheon saw.」

A shadow confronting the snake covering the sky.

There was a giant standing before the snake king, who had everyone kneeling.

[The martial arts world I think of is a 'forest'.]

A voice filled with majestic spirit.

Despite the roar of the Imoogi King, the giant silently looked around at the martial arts people and asked a question.

[I'll ask. What do you think the 'martial arts world' is?]

It was just a question. However, no one there dared answer. The being who asked the question was too great.

So instead of answering the question, the martial arts people decided to accept the questioner's answer.

"Everyone gather!"

The elders shouted. The martial arts people supported the fallen martial arts people. Like trees entwining each other’s roots, the martial artists stood supporting each other.

The martial arts world soon became one forest.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint has arrived!"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint .

That day, Namgung Jincheon first learned that name.

[That is your answer.]

A being whose strength cannot be measured by any skill she possessed.

An incarnation that directly repels the Outer God that even the Constellations fear.

[We cannot let the forest collapse because of a single snake.]

The night sky was breaking apart. Namgung Jincheon sank to the ground as he watched the horde of swords rising like meteors from the sword pole and the body of the Imoogi King being torn apart helplessly.

[Are you the new head of Namgung's household?]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint , who had already come down to earth, was looking at him. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint offered him something as he gasped for breath, unable to even answer.

[Eat it.]

It was a dumpling. Namgung Jincheon thought as he chewed the dumpling he received with trembling hands.

The strongest in this martial arts world was not one of the ten best martial artists in the world, nor Namgung Sega-ju, nor even the Constellations of great men.

「The strongest in the first martial arts world is 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung'.」

Dozens of years had already passed since that day, and Breaking the Sky Sword Saint went into seclusion again. Naturally, the taste of the dumplings from that day had also disappeared from his memory.

And now, Namgung Jincheon was selling the memories of that day to earn coins.

"Our Respectable Masters really liked martial arts dumplings, didn't they?"

"Oh, are these really the dumplings from that day?"

"Yes."

It was nonsense. Namgung Jincheon could no longer remember what the dumplings from that day tasted like.

"I miss those days."

What was important now was the Namgung Family's martial arts dumplings that were about to be launched. And the enormous coins those dumplings would earn. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who they couldn't even tell if she was alive or dead; Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who helped Namgung Sega;they were no longer important to him.

That was when the head of a little boy caught his eye.

'A beggar?'

A boy with messy hair was eating dumplings nearby.

Namgung Jincheon tried to signal the boy to move away with his eyes, but when he saw the boy's face hidden under the messy hair, he was greatly impressed.

'What a handsome boy. He's similar to me when I was young.'

Namgung Jincheon smiled happily as he watched the boy munching on dumplings like he did in his youth.

That was until the little boy in question opened his mouth.

"The filling of the dumplings wasn't cooked evenly."

At first, he thought he had heard wrong.

"These aren't Murim dumplings."

He heard a murmur from the surroundings. Fortunately, it seemed that not many people had heard the boy yet. Namgung Jincheon, who smiled awkwardly, shrugged his shoulders and covered up the situation.

Right now, he could have just let it go. The kid's words were not important at all. What was important was the results of the 'dumpling competition' that he was about to announce—

"This is not a Murim dumpling."

The voice resonated clearly. This time, it was filled with internal energy, so he couldn't ignore it.

Namgung Jincheon narrowed his eyes and asked.

"Who is this boy?"

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."

Namgung Jincheon tilted his head.

Yoo Joonghyuk? I've heard that name somewhere.

"How dare you! Do you know who this person is—"

The Namgung Sega's warriors approached him and began to show off their aura toward the kid. However, the kid didn't even blink.

Namgung Jincheon looked down at the kid with a cold gaze and asked.

"You are a very spirited boy. Where is your master?"

Sighs came out from everywhere.

In this situation, asking the master meant that Namgung Sega had made up his mind.

Some said that the kid was finished, and others said that even the kid's master was finished.

And when the kid finally said his master's name.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

Everyone there fell silent.

The ominous smile of Namgung Jincheon broke the silence.

"From now on, this boy will have to take responsibility for his answer."

After a while, we were captured and taken away by Namgung Sega's men (to be exact, only Yoo Joonghyuk was taken away, and I was hiding in Yoo Jonghuk's pocket).

Before we knew it, we could see the wooden mansion of Namgung Sega in the distance. It was a truly magnificent mansion at a glance.

They say that the Five Great Families of martial arts are the best, so I guess they must have made a lot of coins.

I can see a broken barn over there. I guess the barn we destroyed the roof of was also Namgung Sega's.

—Kim Dokja.

—What.

—I did as you told me.

—Good job.

In fact, revealing the truth in front of Namgung Jincheon was our plan. To be honest, I didn't know Yoo Joonghyuk could act this well.

—What's the next plan?

—There isn't one.

Yoo Joonghyuk was silent for a moment as if he was trying to figure out what I meant, then glared at me and said.

—You, what are you up to right now…

—Just stay still.

—Don't you know who that guy is? It's Namgung Jincheon, the King of the Five Great Sega-ju.

—I know. Namgung Sega-ju, who has a completely different personality, would you fight Jaerang?

—If you fight like this, you'll lose to anyone.

—Really? Then just stay still.

—You.

—One thirty steps to the southwest.

—What?

—Two fifty steps to the northeast.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked around hurriedly at my words. I added, stopping Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Don’t look back. It’ll catch their eye.

I have been activating the story fragment ever since Yoo Joonghyuk met Namgung Jincheon.

[Story fragment 'Daytime Words Are Heard by Birds' continues its storytelling.]

This story fragment does not simply listen to words. If you concentrate and listen carefully, you can even read the unique presence conveyed in the breathing sound.

And within a hundred meters radius, there were a few well-hidden incarnations.

—Have you ever made anything like a grudge in the martial arts world?

—I just made one.

—Not Namgung Jincheon.

—None.

You shouldn’t take Yoo Joonghyuk’s 'none' at face value. That guy just hung up on his enemies who were jealous and envious, even though he didn’t know it himself.

—Then the answer is already set.

—The Constellations’ subordinates.

I nodded.

The Constellations that lost us near the 'Void Curtain' had deployed their incarnations to the scenario area inside the curtain.

—I don’t think we’ve been caught yet. I think they’re hesitating too.

—But it’s just a matter of time.

—Yes. That’s why we carried out this operation.

Yoo Joonghyuk’s steps paused for a moment. Only then did he realize it.

—No way.

The only way to protect us in this martial arts world while being chased by the Constellations.

—If Namgung Sega is here, the Constellations won’t be able to invade easily. Since the 'Outer God incident', Namgung Sega has been estranged from the Constellations.

—Is that why you provoked Namgung Jincheon?

—That’s right.

Since when has the name 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' been taboo for Namgung Sega?

—I don’t know about others, but I believed that Jewang Swordsman would be caught. He had tried to enter 'Breaking the Sky Swordsman' before.

It’s a secret story that only appears in 'Ways of Survival', but Namgung Jincheon was impressed by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint’s martial arts and visited her several times. It was to learn Breaking the Sky Sword Saint’s martial arts.

—You know quite a bit about him. Then you should know how he’s going to treat us now.

—He won’t harm us. On the surface, that is.

In 'The First Martial Arts World', Jewang Swordsman is known as a gentleman. So, in order to protect that image, he won't hurt us until the 'Dumpling Competition' is over.

The problem is what comes next.

—Do you think he'll take us to Sega and treat us to delicacies?

—How could he possibly do that? We'd be thrown in prison right away. We could even be beaten with a stick.

—I don't want to get beaten with a stick.

Of course, I don't intend to do that. In this world, the only one who can beat Yoo Joonghyuk's butt is Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

—If you come out like that, show them a little Breaking the Sky Sword Saint martial arts. You can just show them a simple first step.

—Do you think he'll help us then? Because he tried to be taught by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint before?

—No, you'll be shocked. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who refused him saying that it's a martial art that only women can learn, has taken another little boy as his disciple. Maybe he'll take off your pants first.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been walking smoothly, stopped dead in his tracks. I felt the startled Namgung Sega's warriors looking back at Yoo Joonghyuk.

I quickly added before Yoo Joonghyuk went berserk.

—Listen. This is still the fastest way.

—I don't need to listen to you anymore.

—You have to listen. This is the fastest way to meet 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'.

Yoo Joonghyuk said. His memories will be completely restored in three days, which meant that if we somehow endured for three days, we could escape Namgung Sega and find Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

[Your incarnation body is in danger.]

The problem is that my incarnation body is expected to collapse before those 'three days' pass.

—This is the fastest way?

—How fast do you think the rumors in the martial arts world are?

A kid who insulted Namgung Sega's dumplings appeared in the 'Murim Dumpling Competition' that the 'First Murim' was paying attention to. But what if that kid is known to be a disciple of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' who has not appeared in decades?

—As you know, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint does not have a 'new disciple' right now.

We are not going to find her.

—Breaking the Sky Sword Saint will come to us.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 804 Episode 39 Rumor (3)

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We were locked up in Namgung Sega's Brain Jade.

To be honest, I wondered if it made sense to lock us up for badmouthing their own dumplings, but the group called Odae Sega was no ordinary group.

As soon as we entered Brain Jade, the first thing that greeted us were the existing prisoners.

"Hahaha, it looks like another newcomer has come in."

From the big bosses of the Old Murim generation to the criminals of the New Murim. The prisoners who found Yoo Joonghyuk were glued to the bars and licking their lips.

"What a soft little brat."

"You were unlucky, brat. Your life is obvious now that you've come this far."

"What a chubby little brat, should I boil it or roast it—"

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the prisoners with indifferent eyes and then picked out the two men who seemed to be the best among them.

"Blade Hand, Jeon-geuk. The Lazy Sword, Lee Cheol-gun."

The men who had been called by nicknames by Yoo Joonghyuk opened their eyes wide and muttered.

"Huh, how did our nicknames…?"

"You will die in the 'Terror Expedition' in 28 days."

A sudden silence spread through the prison at Yoo Joonghyuk's death curse.

A middle-aged man who had been locked up in the opposite prison woke up belatedly.

"You bratty brat, you've really lost your mind!"

"Baeksalgeom Mahyung."

Baeksalgeom Mahyung, whose name had been called, glared at Yoo Joonghyuk with his eyes wide open.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at him for a moment and then declared.

"You will die now."

"What? Keuhahaha—"

Baeksalgeom Mahyung laughed for a long time, saying "Keuhahahaha," as if he had heard a lame joke. And after a while, Mahyung grabbed his heart, knelt down, vomited blood, and died.

"Wh, what's going on! What the heck!"

"Mahyung?"

"What happened? Are you kidding me?"

"Guard, where is the guard!"

A while later, a guard who had been hurriedly dispatched confirmed the death of Baeksalgeom Mahyung. It was a heart attack of unknown cause.

"If there's anyone else who wants to know their lifespan, come out."

With that, the prisoners' mockery disappeared.

I asked inwardly, amazed.

—How did you do it? Did you kill him with a skill?

—I just saw a guy who was about to die. That's all.

The 41st Round’s Regressor. He's scary.

Of course, not everyone thought Yoo Joonghyuk was scary.

"Are you really the disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint? You're so amazing."

The guards seemed to find Yoo Joonghyuk's talent amazing and did not spare their praise.

"Did you really foresee Mahyung's death? I heard that even Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had the power of foresight..."

"By the way, he really is a handsome kid."

Looking at the guards who couldn't stop admiring Yoo Joonghyuk's appearance, I remembered reading a study that said that 'good-looking prisoners' were more likely to receive a lighter sentence in the courtroom.

"Just hold on here for a bit. Food will be served on time. The food in our brain prison is better than you think."

"..."

"Don't worry too much. If you just apologize well, the lord will soon release you. Namgung Sega isn't that vulgar."

Isn't this guy Yoo Joonghyuk just living his life in easy mode because he's handsome?

Well, anyway.

—Alright. Since we've come this far, we should be safe today.

Just in case, I tried using the story fragment 「A Bird Listening to Daytime Talk」 again, but I didn't detect any beings watching us like before.

Namgung Sega has a few masters who have reached transcendence, and there are also incarnations that appear in higher scenarios.

Even this brain prison is designed so that even the most high-ranking Constellations can't easily enter and exit.

As long as we're in the martial arts world, it's hard to find a safer place than this.

I took advantage of the absence of guards to quietly release 'Thought'.

—You're doing something dangerous.

—There's no choice. There's a time limit for transformation.

Although there were suddenly two prisoners in the cramped cell, I couldn't maintain 'Thought' forever.

And I had a plan in case I got caught.

[Item 'Deodorizing Spray' was used.]

[Item 'Travel Bed' was used.]

[Item 'Someone's Old Blanket' was used.]

[Hidden item combination completed.]

[Special option 'It's Dangerous Outside the Blanket' is activated.]

It was a 'Honeymoon Item' combination that Kim Dokja had told me about some time ago.

The completed blanket tent naturally blended into the background of the prison.

I warned Yoo Joonghyuk, who was looking at me with a dumbfounded look.

—Don't talk to me, I'm going to do something important from now on.

I curled up in the blanket and immediately turned on Kim Dokja's sacred relic, the smartphone.

「Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World.」

[There is an unopened 'bookmark' in the file.]

[Would you like to move to the bookmarked page?]

As expected, there was a bookmark marked by the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

It must be a page with information necessary for the current situation.

Flipping through the pages, I checked the tasks that were currently facing me.

One, find a way to repair the incarnation body.

If I don’t repair the incarnation body within three days, I will die.

Two, enter the new main scenario.

Even if I repair the incarnation body, if I don’t enter the 'main scenario' and escape my status as an exile, I will still die.

Fortunately, I could somehow find a solution to these two tasks if I just met 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'.

The problem was the third.

Three, find 'the Second Kim Dokja'.

The Demon King of Salvation said.

'The Second Kim Dokja' is somewhere in this universe. However, for some reason, contact has been lost.

Fortunately, the Demon King of Salvation knew the last location where 'the Second Kim Dokja' was detected.

The problem was that the 'entrances' to that location in this <Star Stream> were extremely limited.

「Read the 999th Round. You’ll probably be able to get help.」

I slowly turned the page while checking the note left by the Demon King of Salvation.

A journey of a thousand miles begins with a single step, and I couldn’t leave to meet the second Kim Dokja right away. For now, the best thing to do was to reread the given 'Ways of Survival' and check the roadmap.

I calmly began reading 'Ways of Survival' sentence by sentence.

I knew that the length of one 'Ways of Survival' was strangely long, but I was surprised once again.

This kind of writing is not in the right mind of the writer or the reader.

「The items that can be obtained in 'First Murim' are as follows.」

Sentences that were so boring that even someone who was stuck on a deserted island and had nothing left to read would probably hesitate.

「How to obtain the Book of Extermination's Martial Arts…」

Excessively extensive settings and detailed descriptions.

「So the Transcendent Seats finally decide to elect the 'King of the Transcendent Seats'.」

「The basic materials for producing the Dark Moon Theater are as follows.」

As I read the dry sentences, I couldn't help but think about the person who pressed down on each and every word of those sentences.

Han Sooyoung really wanted to save Kim Dokja.

—Is that important?

When I raised my head, little Yoo Joonghyuk, who had lifted the blanket, was looking down at me as if I was pitiful.

—It is important.

—What are you doing?

I thought for a moment and decided to be honest.

—I'm reading a novel.

I thought there would definitely be sharp criticism, but unexpectedly Yoo Joonghyuk sighed quietly and sat down.

—You should get some rest too. There aren't many times when we can rest comfortably like now.

Yoo Joonghyuk started his morning meal while being greeted by the moonlight seeping through the bars of the prison. I thought he was a bit weird because he said resting was like eating breakfast, but even that was typical of Yoo Joonghyuk.

In a situation where it wouldn’t be strange if he died tomorrow, one person ate breakfast and the other read a novel.

「When does the Captain rest?」

It was the scene where Lee Hyunsung asked Yoo Joonghyuk in the 999th Round.

「When the old dream stops.」

I thought while watching Yoo Joonghyuk who was constantly working hard.

Will he, who was born as 'Yoo Joonghyuk', really be allowed to have a proper rest? Will his old dream finally end when he reaches the end of this forgotten world line?

I don’t know.

Maybe Kim Dokja or Han Sooyoung don’t know either.

In a sense, the 41st Round is just being written.

What we can anticipate right now is not the distant future, but tomorrow.

—That beating must hurt a lot.

---

The next day, Yoo Joonghyuk wasn’t beaten. He was even released from the prison.

I had an ominous feeling. Could it be that the Emperor Sword Namgung Jincheon was trying to make Yoo Joonghyuk’s insults disappear?

If that’s the case, then all the plans I’ve made so far will be in vain.

More than anything, if Namgung Se goes out, our safety will not be guaranteed.

"Treat him with utmost respect. He is an honored guest."

While being guided by the servants, I had no idea how the situation was going.

Did he go from being a prisoner to a VIP overnight?

—Did Breaking the Sky Sword Saint come visit?

—I didn’t get that feeling.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint didn’t even come, but the way we were treated changed?

This was a situation where anyone could see that there was an ulterior motive.

—Your plan seems to have been successful.

—I don’t know if I should call this a success.

The VIP room of Namgung Se, where only the elders of the Nine Faction Clan and the famous masters of Murim can stay.

Foods prepared by trained masters were being arranged on the table in front of me. Every time I think of Murim, I only think of chicken soup, noodles, and Murim dumplings, but I was surprised that there were so many foods.

Dongpa pork and Ojangyuk that melted in your mouth. And even Peking duck.

Since I was a dwarf with 'Thought', I couldn't eat all these foods to my heart's content, which was a shame.

On the other hand, Yoo Joonghyuk was eating well.

—But can you eat that?

—What?

—You don't eat food made by others.

—What are you talking about?

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had stuffed his cheeks with food, glared at me with an expression that said, "What nonsense are you talking about?"

Oh, you idiot.

Did you forget that you couldn't eat 'food made by others'?

—No, just eat a lot.

I thought it was better. Also, in that situation, he would have had to eat dirt.

The situation was a bit strange, but it wasn't easy to find a situation where he could eat his fill and rest comfortably.

[The story fragment 'The Man Who Eats Eight Meals a Day' begins its storytelling.]

The story fragment seemed to be intrigued as well, encouraging Yoo Joonghyuk to binge eat. While watching little Yoo Joonghyuk's stomach swell in real time, I also occasionally picked up some food to eat.

A whole day passed while we enjoyed eight meals, including breakfast, lunch, and dinner.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint did not come to find us.

Instead, it was Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon who came to find us.

"It feels good to see the boy eating well."

Namgung Jincheon, who came with his characteristically good-natured smile, nodded his head in satisfaction as he looked at Yoo Joonghyuk's chubby cheeks.

"It really hurt when the boy spat out our dumplings."

"They were trash."

"I admit it. It didn't bring out the true taste of Murim dumplings."

Unexpectedly, Namgung Jincheon readily admitted it.

Since ancient times, in Murim, you have to be careful when your opponent is humble. That means they clearly want something.

"Is the boy really a disciple of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'?"

"If so?"

"Can you prove it?"

Yoo Joonghyuk rolled up his chopsticks as I had mentioned before and slowly recreated the first move of [Breaking the Sky Sword Saint].

Was it because it was a first move swung by a kid with no magical power and a chubby belly? It looked like a swordsmanship that wouldn't even break a rice bowl, let alone the sky. Wait a minute.

Did this human forget [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship]?

"Don't reveal that martial arts to the outside world. It'll definitely cause a fuss."

Namgung Jincheon nodded, but I couldn't read his thoughts at all.

Are you really going to believe that?

Do you have no eyes for martial arts?

"This is the first time a disciple of Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship has come to Namgung Sega."

Emperor's Sword looked at Yoo Joonghyuk with a serious look and continued.

"The martial arts world, including our Namgung Sega, owes a great debt to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint for generations. If there's anything you want, just tell me."

What's his intention?

While I was thinking for a moment, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke first.

"We need a doctor who can repair the incarnation body."

Yoo Joonghyuk's judgment was not bad. I don't know what their scheme is, but at this point, using Namgung Sega was the best way.

"I'll call for Divine Doctor through my family."

Divine Doctor. If we could call them, it was one of the best options for now.

Because 'Divine Doctor' was one of the few 'Story Experts' who could repair stories in the 'First Murim'.

"And also..."

"But why are you looking for a doctor? The boy doesn't seem to have any internal or external injuries."

For a moment, he thought he had leaked too much information. Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardened, and just as he was about to say something,

"Is it you who needs a doctor, or is it the friend hiding in your pocket?"

I had no choice but to admit it. We underestimated the Emperor's Sword too much.

Still, it was a group of incarnations that could block 'High-Ranking Constellations', and I thought they wouldn't find out about my existence.

Before Yoo Joonghyuk made a mistake, I got out of Yoo Joonghyuk's pocket and released 'Thought'.

"I was rude."

Watching me bow, the Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon slowly got up from his seat. A strange color flashed across his eyes.

If it had been the case, it would have been a welcome sight, but it wasn’t like that now.

"I know you."

Damn, as expected.

"Your story is famous even in this 'Murim'."

Honestly, I was afraid of what kind of story would spread. However, the expression on Emperor's Sword’s face as he opened his mouth wasn’t all that bad.

"The story of you persuading Arc of the Dragon Head and sending them back to the sky made the whole of Gangho buzz."

Arc of the Dragon Head.

It was a name I hadn’t heard in a long time.

Had the scenario from Seoul Station already spread here?

"It hasn’t been widely known yet, but I also know that you recently had a fierce battle with the 'Master of the Spear' at the Recycling Center."

Something came to mind belatedly.

'Master of the Spear' was once the patron saint of the Namgung family. And I killed him at the 'Recycling Center'.

However, Emperor's Sword seemed happy about that fact.

"I’m grateful to you."

That made sense. The 'Master of Spear' was the first Constellation to run away when the 'Outer God Incident' broke out.

Namgung Sega still hadn't forgotten the grudge from that time.

I nodded and answered.

"I'll accept your thanks. But I don't think you came here to talk about that."

"You're as sharp as I've heard."

The expression on the Emperor Sword's face, which had been slightly smiling, became even more serious.

"I know that the Constellations of the Great Nebulae are looking for you."

I squinted my eyes and swallowed my tension.

Honestly, if the Emperor's sword were to report us to <Asgard> or <Olympus> right now, there was nothing we could do.

"I have something to ask you."

However, if that was his purpose, the Emperor's sword wouldn't have come to us separately.

"Are you, in front of me now, the incarnation 'Kim Dokja', or the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 805 Episode 39 Rumor (4)

Is the current me the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' or the incarnation Kim Dokja?

The question of the Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon somehow sounded philosophical.

[Your stories have been eroded due to the exile penalty.]

I received the modifier of 'Demon King of Salvation' from the Recycling Center.

But did that make me a complete Constellation? That wasn't the case.

To become a Constellation, you have to accumulate five stories yourself.

But so far, I have accumulated a total of four stories.

「Recorder of Things That Will Disappear」

「Rewriter of Fate」

「Heir of the Eternal Name」

「Between the Lines of Truth and Lies」

I thought I would be able to obtain the fifth story if I cleared the Recycling Center, but the fifth story had not yet awakened.

[Your new story is about to bloom.]

[You need a final trigger to bloom the new story.]

I cleared a difficult stage like the 'Recycling Center', and fought countless Constellations in the process. Wasn't that all? At the end, I even encountered a crazy monster that only stabbed. And yet, it still needs a 'trigger' to bloom.

What kind of story is about to awaken?

It was regrettable for me.

If only this story had bloomed, I would have fully inherited the Constellation's status, and I would have been able to more easily resist the [Fate] that I inherited along with the modifier.

[You are currently unable to exert the 'status' of the Constellation.]

In that sense, I was not a complete 'Constellation'.

So what am I as an 'incarnation'?

[Your incarnation body is about to enter the collapse phase.]

I wonder what I should say.

In the end, I answered the Emperor's question with a question.

"Does what I am matter to you?"

"Aren't you thinking of borrowing the 'power of Murim'?"

The Emperor Sword seemed to know my intentions when I came here.

"It seems like you need a comrade to fight alongside the Constellations. Am I wrong in my guess?"

I was inwardly impressed.

Was this level of insight possible for the head of the Five Great Families?

"That's right."

Honestly, that was the biggest reason I was looking for the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

Obtaining the main scenario and repairing the incarnation body were important, but ultimately, the ultimate goal of looking for the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was to make her on 'our side'.

「The Transcendental Sword Masters, including Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, hate the Constellations.」

Mortals who rose to the same level as the Constellations without receiving any help from any Constellations. As long as the enemy I was going to fight against was the 'Giant Nebulae', I absolutely had to gain their favor.

But now, the Emperor Sword was making an unexpected offer.

"The First Murim might be able to help you."

The help of the 'First Murim'. If it is a scenario where the Constellations of the 'Giant Nebulae' cannot run wild, the Five Great Sages of the 'First Murim' will definitely be of great help.

At least with their help, there will be no one in the 'First Murim' who can touch us.

"I will ask you again. Are you the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' or the incarnation 'Kim Dokja'?"

"If I answer that I am the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation', will you report me to the Giant Nebulae?"

Emperor Sword did not answer.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was swallowing five intestines next to me, said.

—You can hold out for three days, then kill everyone and leave.

That is a very reassuring statement.

However, if I hold out until then, I will also die.

"I have not decided what to do with you. However, even if I do not report you to the Giant Nebulae, it will be difficult for Murim to be friendly to you."

To be honest, I could not trust Emperor Sword right now. Because I remember how the Five Great Masters, including him, treated 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' in the main story.

「"They worship strength more than anyone else, but they are a group that mercilessly expels those who judge that they are not helpful to them."」

In the end, I have to choose.

Will I join hands with them here, or will I abandon them?

"I am Kim Dokja."

I took a deep breath and slowly opened my eyes.

"Let's be honest and frank. I know that the status of the 'First Murim' is not what it used to be."

Emperor Sword's eyebrows slightly arched, as if my answer was unexpected. I continued.

"It's all a thing of the past when the Constellations were interested in the martial arts of Murim. Now, there are hardly any Constellations that come here for tourism."

"I admit that Murim is not as popular as it used to be."

"Do you think the 'Namgung Murim Dumplings' you launched this time will sell well?"

Emperor Sword closed his mouth for a moment, as if I had touched a sensitive spot. Whether or not I knew it, I continued to talk.

"The Constellations won't buy those dumplings. Who would buy a product from a scenario area that they don't even see?"

"You'd better watch what you say." Emperor Sword growled lightly. I snickered.

"You actually want to get the attention of the Constellations, don't you? That's the only way to make 'Murim' great again."

I know that Namgung Sega has been 'hating the Constellations' since the 'Outer God incident'.

However, that's literally their external position, and in reality, it wasn't like that.

No matter what, the Five Great Families, including Namgung Sega, were still making backroom deals with the Constellations.

"If I'm a Constellation, am I the enemy of humans, and if I'm an incarnation, am I on the side of humans? Does such a cause have any meaning in today's Murim?"

In that short time, Emperor Sword's face quickly turned red and then faded.

"What you need now is the fame of the Constellation 'Demon King of Salvation' and the incarnation 'Kim Dokja'. I can provide both. If you are honest with me."

Emperor Sword's pupils shook slightly. His trembling fingertips touched the teacup on the table, and a light sigh followed.

"The rumor about the three-inch tongue that even the Constellations were astonished at, was true."

Why are all the rumors about me only about my tongue?

Emperor Sword took a sip of tea, looked at me, looked at Yoo Joonghyuk, and looked out the window for a moment before continuing.

"To be honest, I didn't believe all the rumors about you. Like the things you did at the 'Recycling Center'."

"Well, you don't have to believe them."

The events at the 'Recycling Center' have not yet been fully revealed.

So my fame must have spread throughout the <Star Stream> as nothing more than a rumor.

"I thought the rumors about the <Olympus> Information Bureau and the story about defeating the Master of Spear were exaggerated."

That's right.

In just the twentieth scenario, causing a large number of Historical-grade Constellations to leave the scenario and even defeating Constellations that were almost Narrative-grade is an achievement that is hard to find even if you search through the entire <Star Stream>.

"But even if more than half of those rumors are not true, there is no denying that you are one of the most famous people in the <Star Stream> right now."

"So what are you trying to say?"

"The current Murim needs a new hero."

I could feel his strong desire in the expression 'new hero'.

"Please be on the side of this 'Mu rim'. Then I will help you start the 'scenario' again."

Right now, I am receiving enough attention from the <Star Stream> that I am being chased by the 'Giant Nebulae'.

In that situation, what would happen if Yoo Joonghyuk and I suddenly appeared in the Murim scenario?

Of course, the Constellations would turn their attention to 'Murim' once again. Their incarnations would appear in large numbers in the 'First Murim', and Murim would become a popular scenario region.

For the Five Great Sages who had settled here, it was a great windfall.

"If I do something like that, I will be exposed to the Giant Nebulae again."

"You don't have many options anyway, do you?"

Emperor Sword smiled slyly.

I smiled bitterly.

In the end, Emperor Sword had achieved his goal.

Of course, that didn't mean I was only losing out.

I was also desperate for the 'scenario'. If I could just solve the scenario problem, I could be 'Exiled' for the time being. No need to worry about the 'penalty'.

"What scenario will you give me?"

As it turned out, there were several scenarios I could receive in the 'First Murim'.

For example, the 'Martial Arts Competition' that Yoo Joonghyuk participated in in the main story was one of them.

On the other hand, there is a 'Destruction Scenario' that only starts when a certain scale of probability aftershock occurs.

Since the Emperor's Sword would never intend to destroy Murim, we will probably participate in the 'Martial Arts Competition'.

[You got the beginning of a new scenario!]

It wasn't a bad situation.

Crucially, if you perform the 'Martial Arts Competition' scenario, you can get the 'sub-scenario'.

It won't be as stable as the main scenario, but at least you can prevent the incarnation body from disintegrating in midair.

However, the next moment, an unexpected word came out of the Emperor Sword's mouth.

"Have you heard of the 'Fear Realm Expedition'?"

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Fear Realm.

The Recorders of Fear commented on that space as follows:

「Even the Last Wall a place where forgotten and forgotten Fear reigns.」

On the other hand, the invincible Yoo Hoseong commented as follows:

「"The abyss of the unmanned."」

The paradoxical Baecheong Kyrgios Rodgraim commented as follows:

「"The slowest and fastest path toward 'transcendence'."」

Also, Lee Hyunsung of the 999th Round said this:

「"I'd rather go to the army twice. No, I'd rather go three, four, five times."」

And now Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st Round was speaking.

"It's a trap."

I nodded absentmindedly.

"Those Sega guys are planning to annihilate us. It's highly likely that they've already made a deal with the Constellations."

"Hmm. I guess so."

"Kim Dokja, you don't know. If you go there now, you'll definitely die."

"Did Cheon Inho of the 40th Round die there too?"

Yoo Joonghyuk hesitated for a moment and then answered.

"Cheon Inho didn't die."

"Then I wouldn't die either."

"You are not Cheon Inho."

Yoo Joonghyuk made a fierce voice.

"With your mental state, you will die at the entrance to the Fear Realm."

"By the way, you managed to not forget the information that the Fear Realm is dangerous."

It must mean that it was information that should not be forgotten even in this situation. I scratched my cheek and continued speaking.

"Still, it is a place that we must visit someday."

"That someday is not now."

Maybe Yoo Joonghyuk from the last round had also been to the 'Fear Realm'. Of course, he may not have been able to see the end, but he must have at least gone to the entrance.

"It’s different from the last round. What the Emperor Sword suggested this time is…"

"It was to confirm the end of the Fear Realm."

「"I want to confirm the 'end of the Fear Realm' for the first time in Murim."」

The Fear Realm is a very special place in this 'First Murim'. Because the Imoogi spirit that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint defeated also originated from the 'Fear Realm'.

"The Fear Realm Expedition is the 'main scenario'."

"…"

"If I accept this scenario, I can escape from being an 'exile'. If you don't help me, I'll go alone."

Yoo Joonghyuk hesitated, perhaps taken aback by my answer.

"You—"

"Of course, if you help me, it'll be even more worth it."

"…"

"More than anything, don't you have a reason to go to the 'Fear Realm'?"

I know Yoo Joonghyuk is right. If we enter the Fear Realm now, the probability of our deaths is much higher. Nevertheless, this was the best choice we could make right now.

"Our enemies won't wait."

The Fear Realm is a place that even the Constellations fear. If I could just enter there, I might be able to avoid the pursuit of the 'Giant Nebulae' for the time being.

After thinking for a while, Yoo Joonghyuk frowned and muttered.

"Do you know what the Fear Realm is?"

"Just a little bit. It's a scary place."

"You don't think the Fear Realm is some kind of haunted house experience, do you?"

"It's scarier than that. But that's okay. Kim Dokja enjoys thrills."

By the way, thrills aren't my story.

I'll be honest.

The truth is, I'm scared.

I absolutely don't want to go to the Fear Realm. But damn it, I had no choice but to go this time.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' wants to participate in the 'Fear Realm Expedition'.]

Because the being I was looking for was beyond that 'Fear Realm'.

「"Youngest, the Second is in the Dark Dimension inside the 'Fear Realm'."」

It was time to go meet the Second problem child.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 806 Episode 39 Rumor (5)

Namgung Sega sent me a Divine Doctor as promised. The Divine Doctor, who was examining my condition, was impressed and suddenly said a word.

"It's the first time I've seen such a damaged incarnation in half a century. Did you participate in the Holy Demon War?"

"I've been through something similar."

"Your mouth is still alive."

"That's fortunate."

"It seems like your mouth is the most damaged."

The Divine Doctor groaned and stroked my arms and legs, then took out a brush and activated a skill.

A bright ray of light and a tickling sensation came over me, and soon I saw my broken incarnation's body being repaired wherever the Divine Doctor's brush touched.

Is this the 'story repair' I've only heard of?

It was truly a mysterious power.

Of course, it didn't seem easy for even such a Divine Doctor to repair my incarnation. The reason was clear.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' growls.]

"That's right."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' twitches.]

"Just stay still, you punk."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been watching the treatment, opened his mouth.

"I didn't know the doctor was an elf."

"Is it strange that an elf is here?"

"There's nothing strange about it in the current Murim."

After Murim was opened, various races flowed into the 'First Murim'. From elves, orcs, gnomes, Dokkaebis, and other races to demons and non-humans.

The doctor, Lowellin, was also a doctor who flowed into the 'First Murim' right after the 'Outer God Incident'.

"Whew, the outline is over."

"You didn't paint it enough."

When Yoo Joonghyuk, who was checking my condition from the side, pointed it out, the doctor clicked his tongue and said.

"That was left there on purpose. In order to maintain the self-sustaining power of the story, the rule is to leave at least a 'hole'."

I couldn't quite understand it, but I felt like I knew what he meant.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was next to me, also seemed to have gained some kind of enlightenment from those words, and suddenly sat cross-legged and began to practice.

The doctor, who was watching Yoo Joonghyuk, continued speaking.

"As you know, this treatment is only a temporary measure. There is a limit to enduring the 'exile penalty' by repairing stories."

As expected, the doctor had figured out my condition.

"If you don't enter the main scenario, your incarnation body will eventually collapse."

"Yes, that's right."

The doctor scratched his cheek with a trembling expression, perhaps because my reaction was unexpected.

"This is the first time I've seen such a calm exile. Aren't you afraid of death?"

"Of course I am."

Suddenly, I was afraid that the Constellations of the Giant Nebulae would descend, and I was afraid that an unexpected scenario would hit me in the back of the head. There were many times when I suddenly got goosebumps at the fact that I could die at any moment.

But, somehow, as time passed, I felt like I was getting used to that fear.

It was like the 'me' who was afraid of death and the 'me' who was reading this story were separated.

I was afraid of death, but I was still curious about the next story. I was curious about the sentence that would be written next.

As I continued to fight with my curiosity, sometimes my death didn't feel like such a big deal.

After all, isn't this something that Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk have experienced many times?

"Looking at your eyes, you don't seem to be in your right mind, so you should suspect that stories are controlling you!"

"What story do you think I'm being controlled by?"

"I don't know. To be honest, I've never seen an incarnation that has chosen stories as bizarre as yours."

The doctor continued, lightly dusting the grains of stories into the air.

"And even if I'm a story expert, it doesn't mean I know all of the stories. The 'following' that we mortals can understand are nothing more than the dust of the universe."

"There's a story that says that dust can make a mountain, right?"

The doctor frowned as if he didn't like my nitpicking.

"There is a story like that. It's the fate of mortals to somehow grab hold of the dust and make the universe possible."

"From what you say, it seems that even the doctor is controlled by those 'following'."

"You really don't lose a word."

"You seem to have barely changed my mouth."

"What do you really want to ask?"

I thought of the description of the doctor Lowellin described in the 'Ways of Survival'.

「Lowellin, a story expert who is counted among the top ten in the <Star Stream>.」

It wasn't easy to accidentally encounter such a 'story expert'. Even Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been through countless rounds, could only count on one hand the number of times he had met such people in person.

I decided to seize the opportunity to talk to a person who was not sufficiently described in 'Ways of Survival' or 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

"There is a story I want to tame."

"What kind of guy is it?"

"It is a guy who wants to dye the entire world the same color."

The story expert smirked at my answer.

"I know what kind of guy it is."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' quivers his lips.]

Heir of the Eternal Name.

That damn guy who tried to control my body whenever he got a chance since the days when Kim Dokja's content was low.

It's been quite a while since I've been through thick and thin with this guy.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is about to evolve.]

However, since absorbing the power of the 'Demon King of Salvation' a while ago, his condition has been unusual.

[Your current existence restoration rate is 18.8%.]

[The level of the corresponding story meets the evolution criteria.]

The story, who was already born as a 'Semi-Mythical level'. There was a high possibility that this guy would become a 'Mythical level story' once the evolution process was over.

I was excited, but also scared.

Even now, he doesn't listen to me at the Semi-Mythical level, so I can't even imagine how much trouble he'll cause when he becomes a Mythical level.

The story expert laughed heartily as if he understood my fear.

"Everyone has a story like that. In order to control that story, you have to know the story well. How much do you know about that story?"

At that moment, the story expert's question sounded like the following to me.

"How much do I know about Kim Dokja?"

I thought about it carefully and answered honestly.

"I thought I knew it well, but these days, it seems like I don't know it at all."

"You'll look at the stories often."

"I've already seen them a lot, but will it help if I keep looking at them?"

"Even stories you've already seen look new when you look at them again."

Read again.

This was something that Kim Dokja often said.

"Stories are mysteriously incomparable. Even though I believed I had interpreted it correctly, when I looked at it again, new interpretations poured out."

It wasn't that much of a new insight.

I thought that even if I were a story expert, I couldn't punish him, so the story expert asked again.

"Why do you want to control the story well?"

"I want to become stronger."

"You seem strong enough already."

It may be true depending on how you look at it. I'm already stronger than most martial artists. If only the stories could be restored, I could easily fight against the historical-grade constellations, and if I could draw out the power of the Kim Dokja fragments, I could even have power comparable to that of the 'Demon King of Salvation.'

But that's not enough.

While being chased by the Giant Mebulae, while facing the Outer Gods—while watching the Myth-level Constellations and Jaewhan, I realized it clearly.

I'm ridiculously weak right now.

If a Myth-level Constellation really snaps its fingers, I'll be destroyed.

In my current state, even if I die and wake up, I won't be able to see the ending.

"I have to become much stronger."

"You want to become stronger."

The Divine Doctor who muttered that thought for a moment, then suddenly wrote "Hoo-hoo" in the air with a brush.

"What does this look like?"

"'Hoo-hoo'."

"So what does that mean?"

"What does it mean? Isn't it just a bad laugh?"

It's my personal taste, but I don't like people who laugh "Hoo-hoo." That's because all of those who laugh like that have a bad side.

"It might seem that way to you now. But what about someone else? For example, how would someone with hot food in front of them interpret this word?"

After a short thought, I answered.

"I'd think it's breath trying to cool the food down."

"What if someone was thrown into a cold snowy mountain and their hands were frozen?"

"Well, it's like trying to warm their hands..."

Only then did I think I understood what the Doctor was trying to tell me.

"If you look into the story with one desire, the story might not tell you much new."

At that moment, I felt like I would forgive the story expert if he laughed, "Haha."

"Then what should I do?"

"I don't know either."

"Huh?"

"First, look into the story a lot. Look into it while you're eating, look into it while you're sleeping. Look into it when you think of it while you're doing something else. As time goes by, your stories of looking into those stories will pile up again. The story will help you."

I nodded in admiration at his words. I thought it was a good idea to talk to him again, and I also thought that the <Star Stream> is really wide and deep.

Even characters who are not well described in 'Ways of Survival' or 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' interpret the world with their own insights. Perhaps the first thought I should abandon is the prejudice that 'I already know this world'.

"If I have a new interpretation of the story, will I be able to become as strong as I want?"

"I don't know how much you want, but there is a saying. 'Sometimes a very small interpretation of the story can change the entire universe.'"

"Good. Is that what a constellation said?"

"That's what a Recorder of Fear said."

A Recorder of Fear.

I never thought I would hear that name here.

"Do you know about the Recorders of Fear?"

"Those who repair the final records at the forefront of the stories. All 'story experts' have heard their stories at least once. Why, are you interested in them too?"

There are brief mentions of the 'Recorders of Fear' in the 'Ways of Survival' as well.

However, some of the content was so abstract, and some was so difficult that it was difficult to figure out what was 'useful information'.

No wonder even 'Kim Dokja' knew almost nothing about Recorders of Fear.

But who would have thought that a story expert knew information that even Kim Dokja didn't?

"Actually, I've met one of them."

"You've met a Recorder of Fear?"

This time, the story expert was surprised.

"Yes. It was a short meeting."

'Lycaon', whom I met at the 'Recycling Center', said that he was the lowest of the 'Recorders of Fear'. And told me to find the other Recorders and find the loss of the world.

So I thought.

「Maybe the secret of this '41st Round' is related to the 'Recorders of Fear'.」

The doctor checked the stencils on my face again, as if he was shocked by the fact that I had encountered a 'Recorder of Fear'.

"Are you saying that you are still sane after encountering them? What on earth did you talk about? Did this snout get damaged at that time?"

"We didn’t talk much. But is it really surprising that I met them?"

"You, it seems like you really don’t know anything about the 'Recorders of Fear'."

The story expert shook his head and added.

"I don’t know much about the Recorders of Fear either. There are just a few commonly known facts."

"What is it?"

"One is that they are trying to record the 'Primal Fear'."

Primal Fear.

I thought for a moment about what that might mean.

"And?"

"The two are that none of those who encountered them came back to their senses."

"Why is that?"

"Well... no, you said you met them?"

"That's true."

"Haven't you witnessed 'horror'?"

In the first place, I didn't know what 'horror' he was talking about, so it was difficult to answer.

"Well, that's okay. This is my first time seeing someone like you."

"Is there a third one?"

"Actually, the third one is the most interesting."

I didn't know what the first two were talking about, but I wondered if hearing the third characteristic would make any difference.

However, the moment I heard their 'third characteristic'.

"They usually appear in this world in the form of 'possession'."

A shiver ran down my spine.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 807 Episode 39 Rumor (6)

---

The 'Recorders of Fear' are crashing into this world in the form of 'possession'?

"Are all the Recorders of Fears like that?"

"I'm not sure either."

With that thought, several cases came to mind.

One was 'Bicheonhori' that I met at the 'Recycling Center', and the other was me and other readers.

If the characteristic of 'possession' itself is a characteristic of the Recorders of Fear...

"However, there is this saying. The 'Recorders of Fear' appear and disappear as if they are invading the world line."

They appear and disappear as if they are invading the world line.

I asked, repeating that expression to myself.

"What is their purpose?"

"Well. I guess it's to interpret 'Fear'?"

Fear. That word, which had been repeated before, now sounded unfamiliar.

"What on earth is this 'Fear' that they are talking about?"

"If it could be explained that simply, the name 'Recorder of Fear' wouldn't have existed in the first place."

"Can't you understand it even in a general way?"

"In a general way..."

The story expert began to calmly organize the place he had used. He swept away the story fragments that were scattered in a chaotic manner and neatly put the brushes he had used into his brush. The reason all of his actions seemed to have some meaning was probably because he was a story expert.

The story expert finally finished organizing and opened his mouth.

"What do you think is the greatest story that makes up this world?"

I answered without thinking for long.

"I think it's a 'scenario'."

Everything in this world is made up of 'stories.' And the biggest flow that leads those stories was the 'scenario' hosted by the <Star Stream>.

Tsutsutsut.

I can tell just by looking at the fact that my existence is soon in danger.

This universe is a world where you are granted a 'qualification' just by participating in a scenario. Satisfied with my answer, the story expert nodded and smiled.

"Then where do you think that 'scenario' came from?"

"That's..."

Here, saying that it was actually written by a writer named Han Sooyoung wouldn't be of much help.

Also, even if the designer of the scenario was Han Sooyoung, that wasn't the logical probability that supported this world.

There must be scenarios in this world that Han Sooyoung didn't write.

In addition, Han Sooyoung didn't know all the content of the scenarios from birth.

She must have written the scenarios based on what she learned from other content and her own experiences.

When I thought about it that far, I felt strange. When I thought about it, all the 'great story scenarios' I knew were familiar.

Olympus' <Gigantomachia>.

Eden and the Demon World's <The Great Battle of the Holy Demon>.

The Emperor's <Journey to the West>.

They were all scenarios based on famous stories.

And that's not all? The general scenarios were the same. A battle royale survival game, or a variation of a mafia game.

In the end, scenarios are based on existing 'stories'.

"Aren't most scenarios based on old 'tales'?"

The Doctor nodded again, but didn't smile. It meant that my answer was incomplete.

"That's right. To be more precise."

The Doctor blinked for a moment as if choosing his words, then opened his mouth.

"All scenarios are 'interpreted tales'."

Interpreted tales.

A bright light flashed in my head.

"A very small interpretation of a tale can sometimes change the entire universe."

The elf nodded again and smiled.

"I see you understand now."

"Are the Recorders of Fear the ones who interpret 'uninterpreted tales'?"

"That's what I think."

"Those tales are 'Fears."

Uninterpreted stories are difficult. They are unfamiliar, and sometimes even incomprehensible. The source of that incomprehensibility is fear.

"Even this <Star Stream> has not yet been able to interpret the tales, the Recorders of Fear love such stories."

'Secretive Plotter' suddenly came to mind.

Perhaps the Recorders of Fear admired him because he was the 'uninterpretable being' of all people in this world.

"I heard you are participating in the Fear Expedition this time."

"Yes, that is what happened."

The story expert looked at me with a slightly complicated expression and was about to open his mouth again when.

"The Lord of the House calls."

At the perfect timing, the guard opened the door and appeared. The guard's gaze was unusual, as if he had been eavesdropping on our conversation.

The story expert Lowellyn sighed lightly and looked at me, mouthing.

—I tried to keep you alive, so don't die.

I nodded my head in gratitude.

---

The conversation with the story expert was beneficial in its own way.

The most important thing was the information I gained about the 'Recorders of Fear.'

「Maybe me and other readers are also destined to eventually become 'Recorders of Fear'.」

I decided not to think too deeply about it. Because the information I could know right now was too limited. For now, it was important to deal with the immediate issues one by one.

Steadily, like writing one sentence and then writing the next.

If every moment of my life becomes a story, then eventually this moment will also be written as a story.

In order not to leave this moment as a vague 'Fear', I had to keep thinking and moving.

When Yoo Joonghyuk finished his breakfast, the escorting person came to see us again.

"The expedition team will be announced soon. I think the guests should come with us."

After discussing with the head of the household, we decided to participate in the 'Fear Expedition' as representatives of the Namgung Family.

[A new main scenario is about to begin!]

My heart raced at the thought of finally entering a new scenario. I don't know if it was because I was scared or nervous. I pretended to talk to Yoo Joonghyuk to hide my trembling.

"You suddenly had a trance ritual while listening to the words of the story expert. Did you gain some kind of enlightenment?"

Yoo Joonghyuk shook his head at my question.

"I thought you had transcended."

"If transcending could happen that easily, the martial arts world would already be full of transcendent beings."

"Well, I guess so."

"I have a habit of having a trance ritual whenever I feel like it. I can't miss even the smallest hint of enlightenment."

I realized once again how sincere Yoo Joonghyuk is. No matter how often he acts like a Transcendent, Yoo Joonghyuk is fundamentally a Transcendent who works hard.

He must have lived so diligently to become the ultimate Transcendent after going through 1,863 Regressions.

[Your understanding of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' has increased.]

[The character 'Yoo Joonghyuk' shows you a little favor.]

I was startled by the message that suddenly came.

My understanding has suddenly increased?

"What?"

"It's nothing."

I had to bite my lips several times to hide my expression.

When I first met him, I thought he would never be my comrade.

That was understandable, because 'Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st Round' was considered one of the worst Yoo Joonghyuks among the many Yoo Joonghyuks.

And yet, I was able to gain a little favor from him. That alone felt like enough compensation for my 'martial arts journey'.

"Now that we've entered the Fear Realm, you won't throw me off a cliff, right?"

"What nonsense are you talking about?"

I just shrugged.

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me with a strange expression and added.

"It seems like you've made some progress."

"Did you notice?"

As expected, the eyes of the Regressor cannot be avoided.

In fact, there was progress for me. Not something profound like enlightenment, but progress that was obvious enough to be seen right away.

[Congratulations! Your story has successfully evolved!]

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' has evolved into a Mythical-level story!]

Finally, 'Heir to the Eternal Name' has become a Mythical-level story.

I don't know why this story suddenly evolved. Maybe the story, worried that I would soon die, evolved on its own.

[The story 'Heir to the Eternal Name' snorts.]

Or maybe it was helpful that I spent the whole night wondering about 'Kim Dokja' after talking to the story expert yesterday.

In any case, with this, I finally became the owner of a 'Mythical-level story'.

And the next moment, a bright light began to flow out from Kim Dokja's smartphone.

[The function of the Holy Relic has evolved!]

The function of the Holy Relic has evolved.

Maybe this is the first effect of the 'Mythical tale'.

As soon as I turned on my smartphone, the platform screen appeared first.

…

Episode ■■. ■■ (■) +[??]

Episode ■■. ■■ (■) +[??]

Episode ■■. ■■ (■) +[??]

…

Why can't I see the latest episode?

I pressed refresh several times, but the screen didn't change.

What happened to the serialization record? Or—

「Uninterpreted story.」

My head felt dizzy.

I'm now an exile, outside the scenario.

If that's why this moment was 'uninterpreted'. So what if these episodes aren't visible?

It was a plausible assumption, but it wasn't yet certain.

Above all, there was one thing left to check.

[You can check one comment for the desired chapter using the 'Daily Free Pass'.]

Fortunately, I could still check the comments. Does that mean the series was proceeding normally?

I'll know when I check the comments.

[Now, you can check the 'comments with many recommendations' first without using coins.]

[Would you like to use the 'Daily Free Pass'?]

An unexpected suggestion. It seemed that this was an effect added through 「Heir to the Eternal Name」.

Up until now, it was difficult to gather information efficiently because of the 'random comment confirmation system'.

That's understandable, because when you check comments randomly, it was difficult to avoid comments that randomly spammed Yoo Joonghyuk's name or the Demon King of Salvation's name.

However, if I could see only comments with many 'recommendations', it would be a different story. The fact that it was recommended by many readers means that there is a high probability that it has hit the core of that 'chapter'. Above all, it is highly likely that it will avoid meaningless comments. Of course, there was a function to check 'recommended comments' using additional coins in the past, but as the cost increases with each chapter (after chapter 200, it started to demand a whopping 10,000 coins per comment), recently I hardly ever checked the 'recommended comments'.

But they're releasing that feature for free. I couldn't miss this opportunity.

[One free daily ticket will be deducted.]

[Check the comment with the most 'recommendations'.]

I checked the comments right away.

Well, indeed.

—Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i! Eung■i!

Recommended 195 / Not recommended 10

I stared at the empty ■ part between 'Eung' and 'i' for a moment.

I thought that uninterpreted stories are scary, but uninterpreted comments might be scary too. That must be it?

Why on earth did this comment get the most upvotes?

I can't understand what Kim Dokja is thinking right now.

I checked the second comment.

—

Pang■Pang■Pang■

# 808 Episode 39 Rumor (7)

---

I felt anxious. If the 'comments' I just saw were true, something terrible would happen to Yoo Joonghyuk from now on.

Surprised by the disappearance of Yoo Joonghyuk, who was escorted with me, I hurriedly ordered someone to search the area.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

I called Yoo Joonghyuk's name several times.

Yoo Joonghyuk could die. No, maybe he's already dead. If that happens-

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

And after a while, the guy's head appeared between the crowd.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who appeared with one of his escorts, was glaring at me with his characteristically sullen eyes.

"What?"

"No, what if you suddenly disappear like that?"

"There were some Murim dumplings nearby."

When I looked closely, I saw a small dumpling in the guy's mouth.

No, really, because of that?

"This restaurant's Murim dumplings have inherited some of the original recipes. It's my favorite restaurant."

In the main story, Yoo Joonghyuk disappeared because of dumplings.

The reason Yoo Joonghyuk eats Murim dumplings every time he visits Murim is probably because of his memories of Breaking The Sky Sword Saint.

Every time he swallows one of those dumplings, Yoo Joonghyuk must be constantly reminiscing about those days.

In short, that ritual is a necessary procedure for Yoo Joonghyuk to live while remembering the past rounds.

"Even if you look at it that way, I don't think I'll give it to you."

"I won't eat it."

I don't know. It seems like he just eats because he has to eat eight meals.

The guards guarding him also seemed somewhat surprised at the sight of little Yoo Joonghyuk eating. It made sense since he was eating two dumplings in one bite.

"Yoo Joonghyuk, it's difficult if you disappear like that so suddenly."

It was clear what they were thinking just from the looks the guards exchanged.

「Is that guy really a disciple of Breaking The Sky Sword Saint?"」

After a while, we arrived at Cheongryongseong Square. In the center of the square, a huge banner with the words '191st Fear Expedition' was fluttering.

[The main scenario area is nearby.]

The Namgung Sega's unmanned personnel pointed to the entrance of the venue and said.

"The head of the family is waiting inside."

The inside of the venue was already crowded with people. Participants in the 'Fear Expedition'. And the incarnations who came to see them off or watch them.

"The leader of this expedition is from Namgung Sega?"

"So the leader of the expedition is Namgung Myoung, the head of the small family?"

"That's the rumor. How could that be? There's no way that a promising star of Sega would participate in a scenario where they're going to die..."

I tried to ignore the ominous words. In any case, entering the 'main scenario' was the priority right now.

We stepped into the venue without hesitation. To be exact, that was what we were going to do.

[You are not allowed to enter the 'event venue'.]

What?

[You are an 'exile'.]

[You are not allowed to enter the venue without proof of identity.]

It was a disconcerting message.

It's not another scenario, but 'proof of identity' is required for the 'Fear Expedition'?

Did they find the spark flowing through my body? I saw the gatekeepers guarding the venue running towards me.

Fortunately, the guards of Namgung Sega came forward.

"Step back. He is a distinguished guest of Namgung Sega. The guards were ordered by the Sega family to allow him to participate in the competition!"

The guards did not back down easily despite the threats of the guards.

"Even if he is a guest of Namgung Sega, we cannot allow 'exiles' in. That is the rules of the venue."

I realized once again how exiles are treated in the 'scenario area'.

"Can Namgung guarantee that this person is not an extremely evil criminal?"

"Even if you are a criminal, you know that you can participate in the 'Fear Expedition' if you have the permission of the Five Great Segae, right?”

"If the target is an 'exile', then it’s a little different. If an exile has flowed in here, then he is definitely not an ordinary being. What if he is a great villain who has incurred the wrath of the Constellations?"

The gatekeepers, who were glaring at me with sharp eyes, showed no sign of yielding.

Meanwhile, a shout was heard from inside the hall.

"The inaugural speech has begun!"

If this were to continue, I would miss all the scenario participation orders.

I quickly nodded to Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Go in first.

—Then you...

—I’ll find a way to get in somehow. You should go in first and get a feel for the atmosphere inside the hall.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been thinking for a moment, nodded.

—Don’t be late.

Following that, the Namgung Segae’s warriors bowed to me and disappeared into the hall with Yoo Joonghyuk.

One of them said to me,

"I will inform the lord of the situation. Please wait a moment."

I nodded, but I felt strange inside.

Could it be that the Emperor Sword Namgung Jincheon had not anticipated this situation?

In the first place, the 'Gongpyeongyeong Expedition' was an event that he and the Five Great Sega had planned together.

But he knew that I was an 'Exiled One', yet he couldn't prevent my entry control in advance?

Suddenly, I had a bad feeling.

What if the Emperor Sword's purpose was to separate me and Yoo Joonghyuk?

[You are an 'Exiled One'.]

[You cannot enter the venue without proof of identity.]

I shook my head vigorously.

Even if it was a trap, there was nothing I could do. Even the incarnation that the god had fixed wouldn't last long. It would be a waste of time to wander around looking for another 'main scenario' now.

I had to find a way to enter the venue.

"Is there no way for the Exiled One to enter?"

The gatekeepers looked at each other as if they were troubled by my question, and answered in a somewhat sharp voice.

"If there is a Constellation that can vouch for you, an exile."

Constellation?

Judging from the expressions on the gatekeepers' faces, they seemed to think there would be no Constellation that could vouch for me.

A Constellation's vouch.

I looked up at the pale sky and thought of Constellations that could help me. There were modifiers that came to mind, but I wasn't sure if they would see me, who had been kicked out of the scenario.

In addition, most of the Constellations in that sky were hostile to me. If they knew I was here, there would be more of them who would come down to kill me, not to mention vouch for me.

However, I couldn't delay any longer.

I had to enter the stadium using [Incite] or some other trick.

Finally, I made up my mind and was about to activate [Incite].

"Those guys—"

The entrance to the stadium was tumultuous. It was a crowd of unmanned people who had just started to enter. They seemed to be martial artists from the old village.

"I'm looking forward to this expedition."

"Is 'that' going to go too?"

"Wow, is it the old days? Well, this is a chance to restore the status of the fallen sect."

I watched the martial artists wearing splendid robes as they entered. Judging from their attire, they seemed to be masters of the Jeongpa.

"It's Shaolin!"

"There's a Shaman too!"

Shaolin, Hwasan, Shaman... Masters of sects I'd only heard of through rumors were entering the competition hall one by one.

But at the end of the line, there was a man in a familiar outfit.

At first, I couldn't tell who he was. But when I looked at him once, twice, three times, I vaguely knew who he was.

His face was different, but it was unmistakable.

More than anything, the story inside me was testifying to him.

At that moment, a middle-aged man who recognized me opened his eyes wide and opened his mouth.

"You are..."

There was.

In this desolate First Murim, the one and only Constellation that would guarantee my identity.

---

[You have entered the new 'Main Scenario' area.]

[The 'Exile Penalty' is removed.]

[The new 'Main Scenario' has arrived!]

The air of the 'Scenario' has finally returned.

I was moved anew as I felt the refreshing breath of the story. This was the feeling of being alive—the feeling of clearly standing on my feet and living in the story.

I wanted to check the scenario content right away, but I had to express my gratitude first.

"Thank you very much."

The middle-aged man who waved his hand with a friendly smile on his face. The story inside me reacted again.

[The story 'persistent martial arts master' shivers in joy.]

The middle-aged man who sensed the story nodded as if he was impressed.

[It seems it is listening to you now.]

"You have been very helpful."

The 「Persistent Martial Arts Master」 was once this middle-aged man's story.

"This is the first time we met since Seoul Station."

He was the former head of Seoul Station, and the 'Last Ark' of the Beggar Sect, the Constellation.

The Dragon's Head Ark 'Cheongae'.

[The Constellation 'Last Ark' expresses its joy to you.]

The events that happened at Seoul Station flashed through my mind like a panorama.

A Constellation that wanted to step down from being a Constellation and start the 'scenarios' from the beginning again.

That Constellation, along with its incarnation, appeared before my eyes.

[Your divine power has been revealed.]

"It's thanks to you."

He said that, but in fact, the feeling I got from Cheongae wasn't as good as before.

That was natural.

At that time, Cheongae was caught up in the aftermath of the probability related to the 'God of the Other World' and paid a huge price.

"It seems you've been through a lot without me knowing."

I answered with a bitter smile.

Perhaps Cheongae and I were in a position to understand each other better than anyone else right now.

In a sense, we were both 'fallen Constellations'.

"Didn't the Ark come to participate in this scenario?"

"I said so, to keep the agreement of the Beggar Sect. I came back to where I have an agreement to keep."

Cheongae, who was once one of the best in the 'First Murim', was pushed out of Murim after losing to 'Paradox Baekcheong' and 'Breaking The Sky Sword Saint' in succession.

"I have decided to rewrite the history of my heaven from here. In the world where I fell and escaped."

"You have made a big decision."

A decision that only a Constellation who has acknowledged his own failure can make. Nevertheless, his expression was brighter than ever.

"I thought that in order to understand my opponents, I needed to know the trials they overcame."

"So you participated in the 'Gonghoryeong Expedition'?"

After hearing the explanation, I understood why he had no choice but to participate in this expedition.

「Gonghoryeong is the cradle and grave of the Transcendents.」

That 'Gonghoryeong' was the only entrance to the 'Dark Dimension' in this Murim. And the Transcendents known in Murim were mostly from that 'Dark Dimension'.

The same goes for the Paradoxical Baekcheong Kyrgios Rodgraim and the Breaking The Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung.

"That's right. By the way, since you came all the way here, I guess your circumstances are also difficult."

He seemed to have guessed why I had participated in the 'Fear Realm Expedition'.

"There are many Constellations that support you, including me."

"That's something to be thankful for."

"Of course, there are more Constellations that want to kill you."

I replied with a bitter smile.

"I've heard the general rumor. That you defeated all the Zodiac Signs at the 'Recycling Center'."

"It seems a bit exaggerated."

"I also heard that you summoned Outer Gods with just your three-inch tongue and had a big fight with the Constellations."

Those 'Outer Gods' were probably from <Kim Dokja Company>.

But they weren't called by me; they just came looking for me.

"I also heard that you poked holes in the stomachs of the Constellations that were obsessed with you."

And it wasn't me who did it, it was the stabbing monster, Jaehwan...

"You made a resolution with the naked man who shouted destruction….."

That's right, we went together…

"When I heard that you summoned the Archangels and Demon Kings and tried to recreate the 'Holy Demon War' and destroy the <Star Stream>… I was really shocked."

Some strange rumor is spreading.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 809 Episode 40 Fear Realm (1)

---

I tried to start a Holy war? I didn't know such a ridiculous rumor would spread in an instant.

[Your infamy is spreading throughout <Star Stream>.]

[Your new story is affected by your infamy.]

I tried to make an excuse, but I just stopped.

After all, infamy is fame, so there's nothing wrong with it. If you build up your fame, it'll help your story.

"Anyway, I'm really impressed by you. Of course, I knew you weren't ordinary when you impersonated Kyrgios' disciple."

"Please keep the story of the impersonation a secret."

"Hehe, of course. But why 'Fear' of all things? Are you planning to cause another major accident?"

"We've already caused enough accidents. I just volunteered here to survive. To be honest, I think it'd be better to go to Fear Realm than to fight the 12 Gods of <Olympus>."

I thought it was an honest answer, but for some reason, he sighed.

"You 'volunteered' for the Fear Realm Expedition to survive... You always surprise me."

"Didn't the Ark volunteer too?"

"I've thought about it a lot."

"You're being too humble."

"It's not being humble. I think you and I are the only ones who 'volunteered' for this expedition."

"Huh? Then what about the others?"

"They're being dragged away."

"Huh..."

"You didn't know?"

He sighed once again.

"Do you know exactly what the 'Fear Realm Expedition' is?"

"Isn't this the task of dispatching an expedition to explore the 'Dark Dimension' of the Fear Realm?

"Do you also know why they do such things in the martial arts world?"

"Isn't it because of the Outer God incident?"

'Outer God incident'.

The Outer God 'Imoogi King' who crossed the Fear Realm invaded the 'First Murim' and massacred half of the Blue Dragon Castle's warriors.

In the end, thanks to the efforts of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, they succeeded in repelling the Outer God, but that day, Murim had to experience the horror of the Outer Gods harshly.

"I heard that the 'Fear Realm Expedition' is to inspect the entrance area of the Fear Realm so that something like that doesn't happen again."

Of course, what Emperor's Sword asked me and Yoo Joonghyuk was to confirm the 'End of the Fear Realm', but honestly, I had no intention of granting such a request.

「The 'End of the Fear Realm' is not properly described in the 'Ways of Survival'.」

Why would we do something like that when our lives are at stake? Will you do it?

"They say that the Fear Realm is a scary place, but I heard that the strategy for the beginning and middle areas is quite well known."

No matter how high the nightmare of the 'Fear Realm Expedition' is, this expedition had already passed the 100th time.

While there were numerous deaths, the martial artists began to gradually figure out the strategy for the 'Fear Realm', and some were quite well-versed in the beginning and middle areas in particular.

Among the masters of the Five Great Sages, there were those who quickly reached transcendence through the 'Fear Realm' strategy.

I also obtained information related to it through the 'Ways of Survival'.

So no matter how terrifying the 'Fear Realm' was, I was confident that I could survive to some extent.

Cheongae, who had been silently listening to me, nodded.

"You're right. The strategy for the 'Fear Realm' is well known up to the beginning and middle areas. That's why the survival rate has been steadily increasing up until now."

"Then why do you think it's dangerous? Are you planning on checking the 'End of the Fear'?"

"That's crazy. I don't plan on doing that."

"Then..."

"To be honest, I didn't just 'volunteer' either."

Cheongae seemed to hesitate a little, wondering whether to say that or not.

"Actually, I was asked to do so."

"A favor?"

"The Five Great Lords came to me in person and asked me to inspect the inside of the 'Fear'."

It was incomprehensible.

Why would they ask Cheongae, a constellation from the martial arts world, at this time?

"As you know, the 'Fear Expedition' is an important event in the martial arts world. It's not only to defend against foreign enemies beyond the Fear, but also because it can produce powerful masters through the Fear."

Cheongae looked around and continued speaking in a slightly smaller voice.

"That's why they've been sending additional expeditions every now and then. For example, the 188th, 189th, and 190th expeditions were carried out consecutively with only a month between them."

It was clear why they did such a thing.

This was especially true considering the strange hostility that the Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon had toward the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

「They dream of a Murim without a single 'God'.」

The 'First Murim' had now entered the process of 'Producing Transcendents'.

"But I heard that all news of the incarnations who entered the Fear Realm has been cut off recently."

"Don't you get cut off when you enter the Fear Realm? It's a place that is separated from the outside world in terms of time and space."

"The lord obtained an item that allowed them to communicate with the outside world from within the Fear Realm about 10 times ago through a contract with the 'Demon King of the Horizon'."

The Demon King of the Horizon.

I never thought that Murim would make deals with them.

"But the fact that we lost contact…"

Cheongae nodded with a heavy expression.

"No one has returned alive from the Territory in the past three rounds."

Maybe because of what Cheongae said. The expressions of the people lined up in the stadium felt different than before. The expressions that I had thought were solemn were now stained with the fear of death, and some even burst into tears or waved their hands.

"It won't be that big of a deal."

I know I shouldn't say such things in the <Star Stream>.

But this time, I had a reason.

"Even if something happens in the Territory, this time, you are here. And above all… this is the 20th scenario area."

Of course, the difficulty of the scenarios gets harder as the scenario number increases.

For example, in the 40th scenario, part of the solar system could be destroyed, and if you reach the 60th scenario, the Constellations could be annihilated. Even after the 80th scenario, a disaster that threatens the safety of the <Star Stream> appears.

However, this was still the 20th scenario.

As long as this 'First Murim' is the 20th scenario area, the difficulty of 'Fear Realm Expedition' cannot go beyond that level.

However, the expression on Cheongae's face when he heard me was strange.

"You, have you not read the scenario yet?"

"Yes?"

"Read it right now."

I started reading the scenario. Fortunately, if you look at the content itself, it was a scenario that was not particularly special.

**<Main Scenario #■■ - Fear Realm Expedition>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: ??

Clear Conditions: Explore the Fear Realm and return after completing the exploration level.

Time Limit: None

Reward: ???

Failure: Death

Participate in the Fear Realm Expedition and return after completing the exploration level. That was as I knew. However, the problem was,

"What on earth is this, Sir?"

"It seems you've finally confirmed it."

This scenario, there is no scenario 'number'.

There was no way this could be.

There have been various types of scenarios so far, but has there ever been a scenario without a scenario number?

If such a scenario exists, this much is certain.

「This scenario may not be the '20th scenario'.」

I had an ominous feeling.

Maybe I should turn around and leave the venue right now.

I have to find Yoo Joonghyuk.

I just happened to see Yoo Joonghyuk on the stage in the venue far away.

"Next, I will introduce the expedition leader of this 'Fear Expedition'."

The crowd's enthusiastic cheers filled the venue.

Yoo Joonghyuk was glaring at the crowd as if he had no interest in the cheers, and was busy moving his eyes. It was clear who he was looking for.

"Sir, I should go quickly. I have to meet my group."

"Okay."

"See you again."

I gave Cheongae a quick greeting and pushed my way through the crowd toward the stage at the convention hall.

In the meantime, the speech on the stage continued.

"The name of this small boy is Yoo Joonghyuk. He is the disciple of the famous 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'."

The introductions were finally starting.

As soon as the host finished speaking, the convention hall was thrown into confusion. It was understandable. After all, 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' had been mentioned.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's disciple has appeared!"

"Are you talking about that kid?"

"He's not a master who has been defeated by the enemy, is he?"

"He's really the disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint?"

"Didn't Breaking the Sky Sword Saint not accept disciples?"

"Why are you suddenly introducing that little thief?"

Emperor's Sword, who was standing on the stage, concluded his speech as if to dismiss the audience's questions.

"Yoo Joonghyuk, the little thief, will be the expedition leader for this expedition."

It wasn't enough that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's disciple had appeared, he became the leader of this 'expedition'. The commotion in the hall was explosive in many ways.

"Oh my! Are you in your right mind?"

"Listen, Emperor's Sword! Are you crazy right now?"

"Don't lie! Breaking the Sky Sword Saint would never accept a brat like that as her disciple!"

"Emperor's Sword! Answer! How are you going to prove that brat is Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's disciple?"

"Where is Young Master Namgung Myung! The original leader of this expedition was Namgung Young Noble Warrior!"

Listening to the crowd's complaints, I now had a rough idea of how things were going.

Originally, the leader of Namgung Sega was supposed to be the leader of this expedition.

But Yoo Joonghyuk, who suddenly appeared, took that position.

"Hey, Emperor's Sword! This time, Namgung Sega was supposed to send a leader! But now you're saying you're going to make an outsider the leader?"

"Not an outsider!"

Emperor's Sword's deep internal energy and powerful voice echoed throughout the arena.

"He's a disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Although he's not Namgung's blood relative, if he inherited Breaking the Sky's martial arts, he's no different from Namgung's family!"

"But—"

"Comrades of the Gangho! Do you dare doubt the reputation of Breaking the Sky Sword Master now?"

Cheongae said. There were no survivors in the recent '3rd' expedition.

Then the reason why Emperor's Sword appointed Yoo Joonghyuk as the expedition leader was clear.

It was truly the utmost love for his son.

"If anyone has any complaints, please speak up. If the disciple of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' is not qualified to be the expedition leader, then who on earth can represent

our Murim?"

Of course, there was no one who could object to that. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyeong was an absolute powerhouse recognized by everyone in Murim.

But.

"That would be when that boy is 'a true disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'."

"T-That's right. That kid is the disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. How can we prove it?"

"No matter how you look at him, he looks like a boy, so how can he have inherited the martial arts of Breaking the Sky?"

The problem is this.

How can we prove that Yoo Joonghyuk is the disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint?

If Yoo Joonghyuk's little penalty was lifted, then it would be different. Right now, Yoo Joonghyuk has even forgotten [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship].

"Emperor's Sword! Prove it!"

The excited crowd looked ready to jump up onto the stage at any moment.

But the Emperor's Sword was calm.

"If I prove it, will you admit it?"

It was a tense moment for me as well.

Yoo Joonghyuk is clearly a disciple of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'. But who would admit a disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint who can't use Breaking the Sky's martial arts?

However, the moment I heard the skill activation sound that followed, I was impressed by the heart of that old man Namgung.

[Someone has activated 'Lie Detection'!]

"I will ask you on Namgung's reputation. Is your master really 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'?"

In the midst of this, the fact that he activated [Lie Detection] was amazing, but there was something else that was truly surprising.

「The Emperor Sword knew that Yoo Joonghyuk was the real 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's' disciple.」

Did he use a [Lie Detection] type skill to confirm it without us knowing? Or maybe he tracked Yoo Joonghyuk's past and found out his martial arts history.

In any case, he really found out that Yoo Joonghyuk was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's disciple and used that fact to create the current situation.

"That's right."

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk answered, everyone was enveloped in a heavy silence.

Everyone in the hall waited for the system message that would follow. And.

Knock.

At first, I thought it was my heartbeat.

Knock. Knock.

But when that sound rang twice, three times, four times. And when the hairs on my arms started to stand up without me knowing it- I realized that something was wrong.

The sky. It was ringing.

"Over there—!"

When I raised my head with someone's shout, there was an incarnation floating there, struggling.

I knew it instinctively. It was the incarnation that activated [Lie Detection].

And there was a huge shadow grabbing his collar.

Up until now, I have met countless strong people. I have witnessed the Archangels of <Eden>, the 12 Gods of <Olympus>, and faced a giant-like Asmodeus.

But why?

At least at this moment, none of them seemed like they could defeat that being in this Murim.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

The god of martial arts was there.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 810 Episode 40 Fear Realm (2)

Did he not know that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint would appear in person at the competition venue?

The heads of the Five Great Families, including the crowd, stood still with faces that were barely able to breathe.

The Emperor's Sword, who was filled with embarrassment, pursed his lips.

"Brea-Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, why are you—"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who slowly came down to the stage, leisurely passed by him and put the warrior she was holding on to the floor. Unable to bear the pressure, the warrior vomited blood and fainted.

No one on the stage dared to meet Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's gaze, and only Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at her.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint said to Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You're such a handsome kid."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had also praised Yoo Joonghyuk's appearance in the main story.

「"Your eyes are burning hot. Do you perhaps love me?"」

Her personality was like a disaster and hard to grasp, but at least to her disciple Yoo Joonghyuk, she was a teacher who was infinitely warm (she did beat him to death once, but let's leave that aside).

Maybe things would work out well this way.

That was until Yoo Joonghyuk stared at Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and started talking strangely.

"Who are you?"

For a moment, I thought I heard wrong.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint looked down at Yoo Joonghyuk as if she was dumbfounded, and then answered with a faint smile.

"I am your teacher."

"I have never had a teacher like you."

What is that kid talking about? Did the dumplings he ate earlier go bad?

She was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint whom he had wanted to meet so badly. But what kind of habit was that to a strict teacher?

He didn't turn away Jang Pan-man.

He turned away? The moment I saw Yoo Joonghyuk's face, something came to mind belatedly.

「Memory penalty.」

That crazy Regressor had finally forgotten his own teacher's face.

"My teacher is only 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's expression changed at Yoo Joonghyuk's answer.

I hurriedly activated 'Midday Tryst' and shouted.

—Yoo Joonghyuk! Who's in front of you right now is that 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'!

I felt the temperature in the area drop sharply.

Sighs could be heard from inside the room.

If this continued, Yoo Joonghyuk would get his butt kicked again and die.

It was then that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint smiled faintly.

"What an interesting kid. Who on earth is the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' you know?"

The situation began to take an unexpected turn.

Yoo Joonghyuk answered.

"Master."

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes became cloudy as he looked at Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. I knew he was thinking back to the past. Right now, Yoo Joonghyuk was climbing the stairs of broken memories one step at a time. To pick up an old sentence that had fallen between the steps.

"She was a person who liked Murim dumplings."

A person who liked Murim dumplings.

"She was a person who liked animals more than people."

A person who liked animals.

"She was a person who would meditate for a long time while looking at the stars falling in the forest and the shadows of the trees drawn by those stars."

Everyone in the hall listened to Yoo Joonghyuk. Some people trembled their lips, and some sighed once more. There was even an old man who had tears in his eyes for some reason.

After a short silence, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint asked.

"Who are you, child?"

I instinctively realized that this was his chance.

To be exact, it was his last chance.

—Yoo Joonghyuk! Release the [Mental Barrier]!

The way Yoo Joonghyuk proved himself to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint in the main story. Maybe I could use that method now.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint has a [Mirror Vision] that can read other people's emotions.」

With those eyes, she could read Yoo Joonghyuk's past like she did in the main story. Then, he could make Breaking the Sky Sword Saint join our side once again.

Fortunately, Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to understand what I meant.

"Who do you think I am?"

When Yoo Joonghyuk's [Mental Barrier] was lifted, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's [Mirror Vision] that shone brilliantly was activated. It was as if time had stopped around her.

My heart pounded.

If she were the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' I knew, she would never ignore Yoo Joonghyuk's past. She would never turn a blind eye to the memories he had accumulated during those terrible years.

She couldn't help it.

However, this strategy also had a blind spot.

「What if Yoo Joonghyuk had not only forgotten the face of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'?」

The worst assumption flashed through my mind for a moment.

「What if most of the memories of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' in Yoo Joonghyuk's head have been erased?」

Soon, the light of the clear sky disappeared from Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's eyes. Fortunately, she seemed to have read some memory from Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint tilted her head and asked strangely.

"Why did I hit your butt?"

Damn, why did she only read that memory?

"I don't know either."

Seemingly absentminded after seeing his master for the first time in a while, Yoo Joonghyuk frowned and added.

"It seems you have that kind of hobby."

"Hmm, I wonder if you can say that while getting hit again."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's right hand glowed blue.

I couldn't help but step forward now. I had to persuade Breaking the Sky Sword Saint here somehow. All sorts of strategies came to mind and disappeared.

「Actually, let's say that I'm Yoo Joonghyuk. And let me offer my memories.」

「How about reciting the information in 'Ways of Survival'?」

「As a disciple of Baek Cheong School, let me declare to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. If I tell her that I know the relationship between her and my master—」

「If I do that, I'll die before Yoo Joonghyuk.」

The moment I moved my body quickly and finally climbed up onto the stage of the grand hall.

Kugugugugu.

I heard the sound of the heavens of the martial arts world opening. The hairs on my arms stood out once again. My body's reaction was similar, but it felt different from when Breaking the Sky Sword Saint appeared before.

My spine went cold and my ears rang. The feeling of an unknown organ vibrating deep inside my body.

The 'fear' from something infinitely different.

"Oh, my God!"

"The Fear Realm has opened!"

The 'Great Hall' appeared in the sky. A pitch-black shadow was coming over that distant hole. I heard the sound of the guards chattering their teeth as they ran up to the arena to stop me.

"Eee... Here he comes, he comes, the master of the great teeth comes, he comes to pierce, he comes to tear and devour, he comes from where the fangs meet, the gap between the teeth and the gums opens…"

I got goosebumps.

I realized anew what kind of beings the Outer Gods were. Beings that could destroy the mortal spirit just by acting.

The incarnations infected by the other world's stories were struggling, shedding tears of blood.

My head was in disarray.

Why did the Outer Gods appear now?

Nowhere in the 'Ways of Survival' did this development appear.

In the first place, could the Outer Gods have crossed the Fear Realm now?

Who on earth gave them such a possibility?

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' growls.]

Fortunately, the foreign stories didn't seem to have any effect on me.

However, the area around the convention center was already in chaos.

"Euaaaaaa! I don't want to die, I don't want to die, the master of teeth, teeth, teeth, teeth is coming—"

Even so, not all the incarnations knelt before the Outer God. Some of the martial artists, including the heads of the Five Great Families, were raising their magical power to fight against the Outer God's tale.

"Everyone, come to your senses!"

The martial artists who came to their senses at the rebuke of the Emperor's Sword each began to draw their weapons.

"Don't worry! We can win! This is not the Murim of the past!"

The first Murim has been preparing for the 'Fear' for a long time since the 'Outer God incident'.

Murim is different now.

At least there are masters here who can fight against the Outer God's incomprehensible power.

"Is that an Outer God?"

A majestic voice was heard through the crowd. The ten best martial artists of the current Murim were standing there.

"Ilgeomtalhon Cheongada!"

"Yongcheondo has also come! The Transcendents have come!"

Finally, the transcendental figures representing the new generation of martial arts appeared.

When Ilgumtalhon drew his sword, Yongcheondo also drew his long sword and responded.

"You're making a fuss over nothing."

In fact, the aura flowing from their bodies was enough to represent their confidence.

It wasn't just Ilgumtalhon and Yongcheondo. There were shadows of transcendental figures appearing on the rooftops of the area.

Even at a quick count, there were more than a dozen of them.

They were the transcendental figures who had gathered to protect the 'First Murim'.

【Teeth, teeth, teeth, teeth—】

The martial arts people whose hair had been covered with teeth pressed down on Ilgumtalhon and Yongcheondo.

Ilgumtalhon muttered as if mocking those martial arts people.

"Hey."

The martial arts people who were losing their heads, saying "Sugagak."

Ilgumtalhon's hands were cruel and clean as he cut down the infected martial arts people.

"Uh, why—"

As if he had forgotten that they were fellow martial artists just a moment ago, his swordsmanship annihilated the entire area in an instant. And.

"Is that the guy who came over from the entrance of the Fear Realm?"

"I've seen something similar in the strategy. A fish-shaped Outer God. An entity with almost no ego."

Yongcheondo, who was observing the Outer God's head, added.

"The story is a typical infection type. It's not a high-risk one."

"If we bring it in, we can handle it."

At the same time as those words, the incarnations of the two masters disappeared. Dugosu, who was wearing dazzling stars, rose toward the Great Hall. It seemed that he was going to decide the match with one stroke.

Before I knew it, Yoo Joonghyuk, who was standing next to me, muttered softly.

"Idiots."

The moment the two masters' swordsmen moved, the giant mouth of the sky opened its mouth as if it was going to tear apart.

I didn't feel any signs of the rooftops that had been occupying the area until then.

I realized the situation.

All the Transcendents of the First Murim had experienced the 'Fear Realm'.

In other words, they had a gut feeling after seeing that Outer God.

The monster that had descended from the sky right now was not an enemy they could deal with.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

I looked back at Yoo Joonghyuk.

Even if it were me, even if Yoo Joonghyuk were to recover his strength, it would be difficult to face that monster.

However, instead of running away, Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at someone.

Maybe it wasn't just Yoo Joonghyuk.

At that moment, everyone in Murim was looking at the same person.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

This Murim's god.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

The only Transcendent that could stand up to that terrible Outer God.

"Why, why did something like that appear now—"

"The scale of probability! The scale of probability must have moved! That means..."

"It's because of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! It must be the monster that appeared because of you!"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's gaze moved slowly. She looked at the helpless crowd, and then at Yoo Joonghyuk. Finally, her gaze turned to me.

Why?

Her eye was shining brightly. She was clearly looking at me, but her gaze seemed to be exploring something else inside me.

Kugugugu.

Once again, the Great Hallstirred. Soon, the snout of the Outer God fully revealed itself. The snout resembled that of a shark.

An alarm bell rang in my head belatedly.

Why does the appearance of that Outer God feel familiar?

[Story Fragment 'Rapid Swim' wiggles.]

Things that happened in the past ten days flowed through my head.

The days when I traveled the void of the <Star Stream> with Jaehwan-ssi.

During that trip, I had absorbed the story fragment of the Outer God that Jaehwan-ssi had brutally stabbed to death.

[Story Fragment 'Rapid Swim' shudders.]

The eyes revealed above the snout were staring at the ground.

It was looking for something.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 811 Episode 40 Fear Realm (3)

A light brain fog occurred in my head, and the alarm bells rang one after another.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' warns you not to have any strange thoughts.]

The story was warning me.

I can't defeat that being with my current strength.

【Stolen TeethRedRedRedRedStolen TeethRedRedStolenStolenStolenStolenStolen】

# not sure here about the outer god's speech

I thought as I quietly hid behind the smaller Yoo Joonghyuk.

Damn it. I think he saw me just now.

The good thing is that Skill hasn't been activated yet. That means there's no chance of me or Yoo Joonghyuk dying in this situation. At least not yet.

"Ah, Father! Please save me! Father!"

A desperate scream was heard from the crowd.

I turned my head to see a man reaching out to the stage.

"Ah, Father, Father is coming, the great Tooth King is coming…"

At one time, he was definitely one of the most handsome men in this 'First Murim', but now his face was sprouting fangs.

"No! Myung-ah! Damn it!"

The incarnation of the Emperor's Sword rushed toward the man.

It seemed that the young man was none other than the son of Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon, Young Master Namgung Myung.

As the history of the Emperor's Sword took hold in Namgung Myung's incarnation, Namgung Myung's body, which had been polluted by the story, began to calm down little by little.

"Ah, ah, ah—"

But the situation was not resolved. Namgung Myung's mental power was not enough to stop the contamination of the Shark Head's story. Unless someone defeats the Outer God, the Young Master would be finished.

However, all the Transcendents that were blocking the Outer God had fled, and soon even the heads of the Five Great Families and the masters were slowly retreating.

Of course, there were still some who did not run away.

Emperor's Sword shouted at him.

"Cheongae! Please!"

Cheongae, the Dragon Head Ark of the Beggar Sect, nodded.

[The Constellation 'The Last Ark' shouts at the sky!]

"Everyone, come to your senses. Cover your ears and close your eyes. Don't be swept away by illusions."

The martial artists gathered around him began to resist the Outer God once again.

Cheongae, who struck out the fangs that had popped out of the sky, shouted loudly.

"Outer God! Go back! This is not your playground!"

However, the Outer God laughed as if they could not hear such a thousand voices. Then, large fangs fell out of the shark's mouth.

Kugugugu.

A shadow rose from the floor of Murim along with white dust.

Gyo-a-byeong.

Soldiers whose entire bodies were made of the teeth of the Outer God began to stab and kill the surrounding martial artists indiscriminately with sharp fangs that had grown instead of hands.

"Kkwaaaaaaaak!"

Cheongae hurriedly stepped forward to block the Gyo-a-byeong, but there were too many of them.

Cheongae, whose face turned pale, shouted.

"Emperor's Sword! Evacuate everyone! If this continues, we'll all die!"

"Fight! Fight!"

Instead of evacuating the people, Emperor's Sword shouted in a curse.

"If you retreat here, it's over! Murim is about to be destroyed!"

However, his rebuke only accelerated the departure of the masters.

In the end, the person who would be the target of Emperor's Sword's resentment was already decided.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Why on earth are you just sitting there! Didn't you come to protect your disciple?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint glanced at Yoo Joonghyuk at that question.

"That guy is not my disciple."

"Don't lie! That kid is your disciple! I already confirmed it through [Lie Detection]! You lied to me. You said you wouldn't accept disciples and then—"

"It's been a long time. You're the son of Namgung-ssi."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint looked at Emperor's Sword with her characteristically profound eyes.

Emperor's Sword couldn't bear to meet her eyes and looked away.

"You've grown a lot."

"I'm not here to hear that from you! I'm the head of the Namgung family!"

"..."

"Even if you are the Four Hundred Kings, I am the head of the household of the time! Before you were Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, you were Namgung's sword! Protect me! Protect my son! Protect this Murim!"

"What is your Murim?"

Emperor's Sword's shoulders flinched at Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's question.

I knew the reason after reading 'Ways of Survival'.

Emperor's Sword had once heard the same question from Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

The year the first 'Outer God incident' occurred.

In the plaza of the collapsing Murim, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint asked Murim.

"I will ask. What do you think 'Murim' is?"

At that time, the Murim people could not give their own answers. So they followed Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's answer.

"Forest."

Fortunately, Emperor's Sword remembered that answer.

This Murim is a forest. A forest where lowly mortals are tied together and gathered to protect each other.

"Murim is a forest! Damn it! So please save Murim quickly!"

Was he proud of himself for remembering the answer in the midst of such dire straits? The Emperor Sword's expression was stained with faint joy.

But Breaking the Sky Sword Master slowly shook her head.

The embarrassed Emperor Sword shouted.

"Why, why are you doing that? This was the answer! You heard this answer and saved Murim back then!"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint remained silent.

Was the Emperor Sword's magic power starting to decline? His face began to turn pale again.

The Emperor Sword, embracing his son, shouted.

"You are the god of this Murim. You have a duty to protect this Murim more than anyone else!"

"In your eyes."

Blood was blooming where Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's gaze landed.

A few of the Transcendents who were running far away had their bodies torn apart by fangs that emerged from the air.

A thousand voices screaming.

People who seemed to have gathered for a moment were now scattering.

"Does that look like a 'forest'?"

With a slap, a thousand people were pierced.

"Yongdubangju has been hit!"

"Kk, it's over. This Murim is over now!"

"Everyone, run away!"

None of them were protecting each other. The warriors running and running again. The cries of children left on the streets.

Emperor's Sword, his mouth open in a daze, couldn't answer. Perhaps, at this moment, he was finally realizing the identity of the Murim he had protected.

"I, I, my Murim."

Murim is no longer a forest.

A relationship woven through easy martial arts represented by [Skills].

They were together, but they didn't share the same history. They learned the same skills and trained for the same purpose, but even Goo Paebang and Oh Daese were different from before.

Perhaps Emperor's Sword also knew.

"Murim is..."

Their roots are no longer intertwined. Now there is no one in this Murim who seeks advice.

The Emperor Sword's hand, which had been trembling, groped the air.

He needed the elders of the Sega family to give him advice. But no one responded. It was only natural. The elders of the Namgung Sega family who had protected Murim together during the 'Outer God incident' had all passed away.

The Emperor Sword's incarnation staggered.

"Why, why do you always ask such things? What is important about Murim?"

The staggering Emperor Sword took a deep breath, holding the sword he had stuck in the ground. His eyes were bloodshot as he struggled to breathe.

"Do you know what was so great about your Murim? It was the same back then. It was definitely not the 'forest' you were talking about!"

"…"

"You, you made Murim like that! Because you, the great one, were so proud of yourself...!"

Blood poured out from the seven holes of the roaring Emperor's Sword. He too was beginning to be infected by the stories of the Outer God.

"Do you think a forest that relies on just one tree is a proper forest? Why did we send people to the Fear Realm? Why did we continue this expedition while dying so much—"

"…"

"This is all because of you! If you had only accepted me as your disciple, if you had only taught the people of Murim, this wouldn't have happened! You weakened this Murim! You are the one who destroyed Murim! You—"

I hit the back of the Emperor's Sword's head with all my might. The Emperor's Sword fell forward with a thud, unable to get up.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint looked down at the Emperor's appearance for a moment and then turned her back.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

The God of Murim had now decided to abandon this forest. So what had she decided to become?

"Are you really going to leave like that?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint slowly turned around at my question.

"You—"

"My name is Kim Dokja."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint narrowed her eyes and said.

"You are not qualified to answer my questions."

I vaguely thought I knew why she said that.

She might have noticed that I was not from the 'Murim', or she might have recognized the Constellation stories within me.

But in reality, it didn't matter either way.

"That's right. I still don't have the 'eyes' to read Murim."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint paused for a moment at my answer.

I continued.

"Unlike you, who has already seen the destruction of Murim hundreds of times beyond the Fear Realm."

"How do you know that?"

A strange current began to flow from Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's entire body.

"It doesn't matter what I know. What matters is the 'Murim' right before your eyes."

"..."

"Isn't there really not a single tree left in this Murim that you want to protect?"

Little Yoo Joonghyuk grabbed my sleeve. It was a warning. Don't say anything more. If you say the wrong thing here, you'll die.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who had been thinking about something for a moment, answered.

"A single tree cannot become a forest."

"I know that too. But Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

What I was going to say from now on was not my language.

"How many trees do you need to gather to make a forest?"

This was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's language.

It was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's return of the question she once asked Kim Dokja.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint blinked her big eyes as if surprised by my question. Her clear-sighted eye began to glow brightly.

I swallowed.

"I don't know the origin of Murim."

I said, supporting the fallen thousand incarnations.

"However, I know the Constellation that was born in martial arts. I have survived until now thanks to the martial arts I learned from that Constellation."

[The story 'Tenacious Martial Arts Master' nods his head while stammering.]

"More than anything, I have a comrade who loves this Murim."

"Comrade?"

"That bastard who can't eat food made by others at all, eats the dumplings made here well."

[Story Fragment 'The Man Who Eats Eight Meals a Day' nods his head.]

I looked down at the little Yoo Joonghyuk who was standing there with a blank expression and continued speaking.

"So, 'Murim' must not perish here."

This Murim is the last 'home' left for my poor regressed comrade.

[Activate exclusive skill 'Baekcheong-ganggi'!]

['Blade of Faith' is activated!]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's eyes widened as she recognized the magical power in my blade.

She must have recognized [Baekcheong-ganggi].

It said I had re-entered the scenario, but it had only been a short time since my incarnation body was repaired. I still couldn't fight at 100 percent power.

Even so, I was Kim Dokja right now, the Demon King of Salvation. As long as I had that name, what I had to do here was clear.

"Kim Dokja! Stop!"

Yoo Joonghyuk staggered and grabbed my arm. I let go of his small hand and smiled.

No matter how much my incarnation body had recovered, I couldn't defeat such a monster in my current state.

I'm not Jaehwan-nim. But I am not Jaehwan-nim, so I will not destroy Murim.

[The story fragment 'Rapid Swim' trembles.]

I looked up at the sky.

That Outer God came here after chasing the fragment of the story I absorbed.

In other words, there is only one way to save the 'Martial Arts World' now.

【TeethTeethTeethT

# 812 Episode 40 Fear Realm (4)

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The entrance to the 'Fear' I was aiming for was the side of the 'Great Hall' where the foreign shark head (the name I gave it) appeared.

【Nisong-eogeumnis…】

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' nods.]

Of course, that doesn't mean I'm going to die like Kim Dokja.

"I won't die, you punk!"

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' tilts its head.]

Fangs poured out from the shark head's mouth. The fangs that poured out became maggots in the air and rushed at me.

I swung the 'Blade of Faith' at them. Just like Kim Dokja once did, I drew lines in the air following the sword strikes he had swung in the way he had taught me.

The maggots shattered with a creaking sound.

Honestly, it may be hard to kill the Outer God 'Shark Head', but I can also take care of the fun guys.

In this way, I am also one of the 'Kim Dokja'. Although I have not yet fully developed the status of the 'Demon King of Salvation', I can use power equivalent to 'The Great Innocent's Sin'. The Outer God must have noticed that too, as it twisted its huge maw.

Kkuddeuk.

The guy's mouth opened and he began to slowly close the crack leading to the Fear Realm. When I thought, "Oh no," the guy's dense fangs had already blocked all the cracks in the hall .

There was only one way.

I had to break through.

Should I use [Bookmark]? But there is a limit to the number of people I can call.

Who should I call to pierce that guy's maw and take me beyond the Fear Realm?

There were a few characters that came to mind, but I wasn't sure. No, there was one person I was certain of.

By the way, that person was,

"Did you say Kim Dokja?"

She was standing right behind me. I could feel her sharp gaze scanning the [Baekcheong-ganggi] that was overlaid on the 'Blade of Faith'.

"Are you a disciple of Kyrgios?"

"I call myself a disciple. Just like that guy."

I looked down with a grin. I was greeted by the sight of little Yoo Joonghyuk somehow using [Hapgongdapbo] to jump here with his immature body.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was also looking at the same scenery.

"Are you now giving me the right to discuss martial arts?"

I don't know what 'Murim' is. However, just because I don't know about martial arts doesn't mean I don't know the people living there.

"Run! Hurry!"

"This way! Everyone—"

I saw the Dragon Head Ark, bleeding and evacuating people, and the god taking care of the patients behind it.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who was looking at the same scenery as me, opened her mouth.

"Tell me."

"I tell you again, I don't really know what martial arts is."

"Are you avoiding the question?"

"Someone lost their ward here, and someone saved an exile who was dying here. All of that happened in the forest with the same name. But is that forest really the same place?"

"..."

"In fact, everyone lives in a different forest, but the people here all call their forest 'Murim'."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint looked down without answering. There were trees there. They weren't as many as before, but they were definitely trees trying to form a forest.

"That's why I don't know about Murim. Maybe I'll never know what it is. But the reason I'm trying to protect Murim is."

I added, swatting away the blade of the flying Gyo-a-byeong.

"Because there are foolish people like me who don't even know what 'Murim' is and are trying to protect this place."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint didn't answer for a moment. She seemed to be looking at Outer God, and at people. She seemed to be looking at the forest, and at trees.

It seemed like she wasn't looking at anything, or maybe she was only looking at me.

"They have nothing to do with you."

"That's why it's more of a problem. They're going to die because of me."

"Is that a collaboration?"

I hesitated. I have never thought about whether this is a collaboration or not.

However, that shark-headed Outer God came here after my story. So at least I have a duty to take that guy somewhere else.

"If this is such a lowly collaboration, will you help me?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint did not answer my question. She simply answered with action.

I felt Murim stirring at the giant's single step.

"Little Constellation. Your collaboration is nothing but a fantasy."

Breaking the Sky's strong energy was rippling in her swordplay.

「Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship is a realistic swordsmanship.」

A swordsmanship that is made up of thoroughly verified sword lines, one stroke at a time, like stacking consonants and vowels, making words, and stacking sentences again.

A design created solely to destroy the sky of those Constellations.

"So prove it yourself."

The owner of that design took up her sword to help me. That meant that at least there was a scenery she wanted to see beyond the uncharted waters I was about to embark on.

"At the place where your 'Fear' awaits."

Just as I chose, she chose too. Let’s give this 'Murim' we agreed on at least one more chance.

"I was born to tear apart the sky where those black stars hang."

The moment the magnificent magic of Breaking the Sky dyed the sky like a sunset, a wall of power surged from her sword. The flying sword lightning sliced through the entire empty space, then soon broke the teeth of the Outer God and created a small hole beyond his cheek.

The Outer God twisted his body as if the wound was painful.

【This■ No■! This■ No■! This■! No! This■ No■! This■ No■!】

Amid the incantations that felt like my head was going to burst flooding the sky, I released all my strength and said my final goodbye to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"Thank you."

The [Way of the Wind] that I had unleashed with all my might unfolded before my eyes. Beyond the broken gums of the Outer God, a crack leading to the 'Fear' was open.

Yoo Joonghyuk's shout could be heard from afar.

I said, feeling my vision gradually distorting.

—Don't follow me. Your body will recover in just one day.

—You!

If Yoo Joonghyuk follows me now, it will only be a nuisance. Yoo Joonghyuk himself must know this better than anyone else. So this is not just for me, but also for Yoo Joonghyuk himself.

—Let's meet again soon.

I felt the crack sucking me in along with the fierce storm of air.

[The connection to 'Midday Tryst' was temporarily cut off.]

Soon, pitch-black darkness swallowed me up.

[You have entered the 'Fear'.]

Finally, I entered.

Into the Fear.

---

As soon as I entered the Fear, what hit me was a terrifying cold air that seemed to freeze even my thoughts.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is invading you.]

My breathing slowly became suffocated. My hands and feet were shaking and my head was dizzy.

I realized that the scenario had already begun. If I just stayed like this, I would definitely die.

But there was nothing I could do. Left, right, front, back, up, down. No matter where I looked, all I could see was pitch-black darkness. What spread out was just endless darkness. And 'me', whose presence was gradually fading away.

I started to feel nauseous. Suddenly, I couldn't hear a sound or feel a breath.

The only thing that existed there was infinity. And.

【Universe.】

'Ways of Survival' describes this Fear as follows.

「It is the cosmic Fear that mankind has faced for the first time.」

As mentioned above, 'Ways of Survival' did not contain detailed information about 'the Fear Realm'.

However, 'detail' here is a somewhat relative concept.

Simply put, the concept of 'detail' in 'Ways of Survival' presupposes that 'an ordinary human, Kim Dokja, can slaughter a ground raccoon like Yoo Joonghyuk. So what this means is,

「In the face of that Great Fear, this is what a 'Player' who has just entered the Fear Realm must do.」

It means that even in the 'Ways of Survival', there is a basic mention of the 'Fear Realm'.

「Inhale calmly and blink your eyes regularly.」

I inhaled sharply. Once, twice, three times, I inhaled and blinked my eyes regularly. Once, twice, three times.

Even though I couldn't feel myself breathing, even though I couldn't feel myself blinking, I believed the sentence. I believed only the sentence and followed the explanation.

How many times did I repeat that?

Finally, I felt my existence being faintly regenerated in the darkness

I am here.

I am thinking about the 'Ways of Survival' here.

「Relax your eyes as if you are staring at a distant object, and blink your eyes as if you are taking a picture.」

I thought of the small planet blooming in the darkness. The planet where I was born. A pale blue dot. That dot is there. There are people who think of me there.

As I thought that, my fear gradually disappeared, and as my fear disappeared, my vision became clearer.

As my vision became clearer, the universe I sensed also began to narrow.

My world exists exactly as much as I see.

If I were not there, there would be no world. No, perhaps the world had not yet been created in a place I could not see.

At least that is what I believe.

[Catastrophic Fear — 'The universe is an infinitely expanding prison' has been unlocked]

[You interpreted the Catastrophic Fear without a hitch.]

I exhaled, "Huh-huh-huh." I heard a sound again, and felt breathing.

[Interpretation success!]

[Interpretation suggestion: Maybe the world is a fiction that is newly created every time you blink.]

[The Fear Realm accepts your interpretation.]

[An ation reward will be awarded.]

The interpreted 'Fear' soon became a legend.

[You have acquired the Story Fragment 'Fictionalization'.]

Holding that crude interpretation in my hand, I looked around in a cold sweat.

A dim path appeared beneath my feet that had been filled with pitch-black darkness until then.

[The 'Main Scenario' resumes.]

The path was black with large and small footprints, as if countless people had already walked that path.

[You are exploring the 'Entry to the Realm'.]

I barely passed the hurdle.

With this, I also obtained the qualification to explore 'Fear Realm'.

[Additional scenario content will be revealed.]

**[Fear Realm Exploration Guidelines]**

—To complete the main scenario, you must successfully complete 'Fear Realm Exploration'.

—Fear Realm's sections are divided into 'Entry Area', 'Middle Area', and 'End Area'.

—You are currently located in the 'Entry Area' of Fear Realm.

—Your Current Exploration Level: 10%

—There is an interpretation for every 'Fear'. Find a probable interpretation and increase your Fear Realm Exploration Level.

I only interpreted one 'Fear', but my Exploration Level went up by a whopping 10%.

To someone who doesn't know much, the exploration may seem easy, but it's not.

The reason I was able to overcome 'The First Fear' was because I already knew what that Fear was. According to the records, ninety-seven of the hundred martial artists who first crossed the Fear Realm died immediately after failing to overcome the first Disaster-level 'Fear'.

But now that there is a strategy, isn't it okay?

That's because you don't know much about the Fear Realm.

For example, let me give you one of the most shitty aspects of the Fear Realm.

> —Warning. One of the 'Exploration Guidelines' above is 'false'.

In this place, even the contents of the 'scenario' cannot be trusted.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 813 Episode 40 Fear Realm (5)

Even the content of the scenario is an unreliable 'scenario'.

That's why everyone says entering the Fear Realm is suicide.

If I didn't know the initial strategy, I would have ended up like the first Fear Realm expedition team.

By the way, which of these instructions is false?

I looked through the instructions from the beginning and checked if each instruction was 'false'.

First, the first instruction.

> —To complete the main scenario, you must successfully complete 'Fear Realm'.

If this instruction is false, I can think of one possibility.

That is, to complete the main scenario, I don't need to successfully complete 'Fear Realm Exploration'.

A guideline being 'false' does not necessarily mean a bad outcome.

If this interpretation is possible, it is actually beneficial to me if this instruction is false. Because it means 'There is a way to complete the main scenario without filling up all the exploration maps'.

And then the second.

> —The Fear Realm is divided into 'Entry Zone', 'Middle Zone', and 'End Zone'.

If this guideline is false, it means that the Fear Realm has additional zones other than the 'three zones'.

According to the records of the previous Fear Realm expedition, the Fear Realm has only three zones, so the possibility of this guideline being false is not high.

The problem is the next guideline.

> — You are currently located in the 'Entry Zone' of the Fear Realm.

If this guideline is false, the problem becomes a little more serious.

If the place I am now is not the 'Entry Zone'...

I looked around because the back of my neck felt cold. There was nothing in particular, but not seeing anything made me even more scared.

I looked at the fourth guideline.

> —Your current exploration level: 10%

If this guideline is false, there is a problem that you cannot know the exact exploration level, but the exploration level itself does not disappear, so it is not a big problem.

The last, fifth.

—All 'Fear' has an interpretation. Find a probable interpretation and increase the Fear exploration level.

If this guideline is false, it means that 'Uninterpretable Fear' exists.

After reading it carefully, I thought that this could be false.

The world of the <Star Stream> is vast, and the Fear Realm has not been interpreted yet.

There are many Fears that neither 'Ways of Survival' nor the 'Fear Realm Expedition' have recorded, so it would not be strange if 'Uninterpretable Fear' exists.

After finishing my thoughts, I slowly raised my head and saw a side road that spread out into the hazy darkness.

I wondered if it was because I thought that a threatening Fear could appear at any time or place. I unknowingly tensed my throat.

「Let's calm down.」

I thought with a single-pointed star for the first time in a while. Now, I felt like I had to think in a special way.

「Don't be scared because you've entered an unfamiliar place.」

Don't be afraid because you can't trust the scenario. The scenarios I've overcome so far weren't much different anyway.

Even the 'Recycling Center' was a scenario without a perfect strategy. However, no matter how difficult the scenario was, there was a solution in the end.

No one else but Kim Dokja and my own history proved that fact.

「Let's go.」

I slowly took my first step toward the side road.

---

【I'm here.】

# is this an outer god speaking? I wonder who....

---

A lot of time had passed since I confidently took my first step. I couldn't tell exactly how much time had passed.

What was certain was that I had walked quite a bit.

Another fork in the road?

I paused for a moment, looking at the fork in the road before my eyes. There were countless footprints on the fork in the road.

The reason these footprints didn't disappear even after quite a long time had passed was because this road itself was a 'Fear'. Disaster-level Fear, 「One Eternal Step」.

The 'footprints' left on this Fear will never disappear. Thanks to the existence of this Fear, the expedition team members who jumped into the exploration were able to easily figure out the direction the previous expedition team was headed.

I calmly started counting the number of footprints.

「The survival rate of the Fear Expedition Team increased with each round.」

The martial artists found a 'route with a higher survival rate' over time. In other words, for a while, just counting this 'number of footprints' could help them estimate a safe route.

「Focus on the direction with more remaining footprints.」

A simple but sure method.

I was planning to follow that method this time too.

But.

「The left path has slightly more footprints.」

This time, I felt a little uneasy.

I wouldn't know if the number of footprints was clearly different, but the difference was slight.

That means that no matter which way you choose, you have to take a risk.

I thought about it for a moment and looked at the footprints that were made more recently. Looking closely, most of the footprints that were relatively recently created were on the left path.

So, left?

After much thought, I took a step.

But at that very moment. In the very distant darkness, I saw something long and swaying.

I literally saw it briefly. But just that 'short glimpse' sent an alarm bell ringing in my head.

「Something with a long neck is looking at me.」

There was no separate message, but I could tell that it was some kind of 'Fear'.

Damn, did I make the wrong choice.

The moment I turned my back to turn back belatedly.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is looking at you.]

I barely managed to take a step.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is looking at you!]

[An 'Unknown Fear' is warning you!]

My instincts were warning me.

It was already wrong to turn back.

If I turned back now, there was a high chance that I would die.

I turned my back again and looked forward. The long-necked thing was still standing in the same place, looking at me. I took a step toward the guy.

The guy didn't react. It seemed like this was the right thing to do.

Upon closer inspection, I saw a white ladder-like thing drawn on the side road leading to the guy. I started walking along the ladder drawing.

How long did I walk?

The eyes of the long-necked guy blinked.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is looking at you.]

[An 'Unknown Fear' warns you.]

# I think it is same for An Unknown Fear

I stopped walking reflexively. The place I stopped was a land without a ladder drawing.

The long-necked guy's eyes blinked abnormally fast and then changed to a different color.

Ah.

Only then did I realize what this 'Fear' was.

The 'long-necked guy' shining through the dim darkness.

That guy's identity was.

「Traffic light.」

I was right. It was a 'traffic light'. A traffic light with red and green lights.

I belatedly understood the ladder drawing I had been walking along.

「Crosswalk.」

I don't know why a traffic system exists here, but one thing is certain: this is also a 'Fear'.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is looking at you.]

I turned the page of 'Ways of Survival' that I had been reading so far in my head.

Was there a Fear related to 'traffic lights' in the Fear Realm?

「There are a total of 14 'Fears' in the 'Entrance Area' introduced in 'Ways of Survival'.」

Out of the 14 Fears that I know of, there is no Fear related to 'traffic lights'.

That meant that 'Fear' was a relatively recent Fear.

I took a deep breath and thought.

Whatever that Fear is, it is a 'traffic light'. There is also a symbol for a 'crosswalk'.

So this 'Fear' is likely to follow the rules that I know.

「Stop at red lights and cross at green lights.」

The traffic light that I could see in the distance was 'red'. Then, the light that blinked earlier was most likely a green light.

「Follow the signal.」

Judging from the fact that there was no 'crosswalk' where I was standing, this was probably the area where they were waiting for the signal.

I counted to ten in my head, then to one hundred. I counted to two hundred. I counted to three hundred. I counted to four hundred, then to five hundred.

When I reached one thousand, I started to feel something was amiss.

Why didn't the signal change?

I couldn't figure out why. Was my approach wrong? Wasn't that actually a 'traffic light'? If it wasn't a traffic light, then what on earth was it?

That's when I heard a commotion from behind.

"Whaaaaak!"

A shattered scream. The sound of urgent footsteps.

I instinctively placed my hand on the handle of my sword.

A group of incarnations were running toward me.

"S-save me! Save me!"

They were martial artists. It seems that there were those who, like me, chose to run away in the face of the crisis of the martial arts world with the 'Fear Realm'.

"Eww!"

They looked desperate, as if they were being chased by something.

"Get out of the way! Right now!"

A martial arts person who had come close to me with a quick light attack shouted at me.

I waved my hand at them and said.

"Wait a minute! I don't know what the situation is, but for now, stop—"

It was already too late. The group of about ten people who had hit my shoulder and passed by had already run onto the crosswalk. Their footprints as they crossed were imprinted on the crosswalk one after another.

The signal was still red.

And.

"Hurry! Run faster!"

Nothing happened.

They were quickly crossing the crosswalk.

I blankly watched their backs moving away.

Was it actually okay to cross?

I didn't really understand. No, if that was possible, why were there 'traffic lights' and 'crosswalks'? In a place like this where no cars are running—

「There are no cars.」

A small realization flashed through my head.

If there were no 'cars', wouldn’t it be safe to cross the crosswalk at a red light? If this 'traffic light' was a Fear created by exploiting such a situation—

The moment I thought about it, my ankles began to tingle.

「Then you should not cross the 'crosswalk' even more.」

Crack.

The sound of flesh being crushed and bones breaking. The sound of organs bursting. The sound of blood vessels being torn. Almost all the sounds that could crush and destroy a

human body were heard right in front of my face.

Even I, who could compete with the Historical-grade Constellations, could not observe the moment of the impact.

['Unknown Fear' is looking at you.]

The sound disappeared and I came back, leaving only the traffic light.

The red light of the traffic light illuminated the quiet crosswalk. On the crosswalk that had been crowded with people until then, only footprints and dark red skid marks remained.

[The exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is activated.]

The rule of keeping the signal is not wrong. If so, the problem is when will 'the signal' change?

No matter how much I thought about it, there was no way to figure out the rule. I guess I just have to wait for the signal to change.

[The exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is strongly activated!]

At that moment, I heard the sound of teeth chattering from somewhere.

It was a familiar sound.

A moment later, I remembered that people were being chased by something.

【Teeth Teeth Teeth Teeth Teeth Teeth】

This damn thing.

【Mirror Mirror Mirror Mirror Mirror Mirror Mirror Mirror】

When I looked back, I saw a shark-head running recklessly from the distant darkness. As expected, the guy had chased me from the martial arts world.

The size of the guy who revealed his complete appearance from inside the Fear world was truly enormous.

The moment I saw the heads of the martial arts people caught in the guy's teeth, I made a judgment.

I must run away no matter what.

The situation was different from the martial arts world. This is 'the Fear Realm'. It was a place where that Outer God could run wild, ignoring the Probability of the scenario.

【Teeth and teeth】

A shark-head behind, a traffic light in front.

There is only one way to survive.

「I must interpret the Fear.」

I thought about the logic of the traffic light in my head.

Traffic light.

A traffic system where the signal changes after a certain amount of time. A certain amount of time. A certain amount of time—

「Time.」

A light flashed in my head for a moment.

「A traffic light that doesn't change even after time passes.」

Maybe I aleady knew the answer.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 814 Episode 40 Fear Realm (6)

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According to my prediction, the reason why the 'traffic light' signal didn't change is summarized in two ways.

One, because there is no 'concept' of normal time in the Fear Realm.

Two, because that traffic light is a 'special' traffic light.

The sound of teeth grinding was heard from behind once again. Either way, I didn't have much time left.

[Activate exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10'!]

Let's do something.

I shouted urgently at the traffic light.

"You can perceive 'time' from now on!"

If the green light didn't turn on because of the 'concept of time', then this [Incite] would definitely work. However, the traffic light didn't change.

Okay, then how about this?

"You are a 'traffic light with a green light'!"

I thought it was a much more certain method than before. 1 second, 2 seconds, 3 seconds. This time, the traffic light didn't change.

Damn, it's not working.

Is the probability of [Incite] lacking?

Is it because they are inanimate objects without egos?

Or do the beings inside this 'Fear' have an immune system against my [Incite]?

I was curious, but I didn't have time to think about it.

If the first method didn't work, it was time to use the second method.

「A traffic light that doesn't change.」

If that traffic light is a 'special traffic light' and doesn't change, there must be some kind of rule. And I think that 'rule' I guess is this.

I slowly closed my eyes and took a deep breath.

How many seconds did that last?

Even though I closed my eyes, I suddenly felt my vision become clearer, and as if by magic, another traffic light appeared next to me.

It was a traffic light that matched the one on the other side. I slowly looked at the pillar toward the traffic light, and the button I expected was there.

「Audible signal for the visually impaired」

There it was! Of course it was! I pressed the button without hesitation. Then, a strange sound began to flow out from the traffic light.

[If you have trouble with your eyes, raise your right hand and cross.]

The mechanical sound that flowed out was quite ominous, but there was still a sense of joy at having guessed correctly.

The moment I raised my right hand and was about to take my first step.

[Exclusive trait 'Record Repairer' warns you.]

My instinct, which has been repeating writing for many years, warned me. If I take my first step like this, I will be torn to pieces and die like those incarnations just now.

「This is not an appropriate interpretation of this 'Fear.'」

I had a strong feeling, although I don't know why.

So what did I miss?

I didn't think long.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' is activated!]

The traffic light said, 'If you have trouble with your eyes, raise your right hand and cross.'

Even with my [Incite] I couldn't instill the concept of time in the traffic light.

But what if the target was 'me'?

"I can't see."

At the same time as the [Incite], my vision was plunged into darkness. In the complete darkness where no light could penetrate, I began to walk with my right hand raised and trembling.

Evening, step, step.

The sound of my footsteps was louder than usual. Is this right? If I keep walking like this, will I be able to cross all the crosswalks? Will a car that came running from somewhere hit me?

The Fear that I might be wrong. That inorganic desolation suffocated me.

As I walked a few more steps, my hearing gradually replaced the place where my vision disappeared. Another world made of sounds was there.

The sounds that had been entangled with each other began to separate one by one in the sharp darkness.

The sound of me breathing. The sound of my steps. The sound of my clothes brushing dry. The sound of a shark's head chattering its teeth.

And... And the sound of someone walking beside me.

【You're doing well.】

I got goosebumps all over my body.

Who on earth is that? Who is talking? I was so scared that I ran across the crosswalk in an instant. When I opened my eyes after completing the steps I had planned in my head, I had already passed the crosswalk quite a bit.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' has been released.]

I couldn't see the person who had spoken to me.

What on earth was that?

Is it an illusion?

[Catastrophic Fear — 'Alien Traffic Lights' has been unlocked.]

[You have perfectly interpreted the Catastrophic Fear.]

[Interpretation success!]

[Interpretation suggestion: Sometimes, you can catch a glimpse of another world just by closing your eyes.]

[The Fear Realm is satisfied with your interpretation.]

[A special interpretation reward is given.]

An interpretation reward was given this time too. However, unlike the last time, this time it was a 'Special Interpretation Reward'.

The real story fragment I had obtained by clearing the first gate was 'Fictionalized'. To be honest, the name of the fragment was so abstract that I couldn't figure out what it was used for, but this time, the reward was different.

[You acquired the fragment 'Wonryo Signal Controller'.]

As soon as I called out the story, a small remote control appeared in front of me.

I held the remote control in my hand. Somehow, I felt like I knew how to use it.

The shark-head that had been running towards me from afar, emitting pitch-black smoke, was shaking its head left and right and looking around. It seemed like it had lost my location.

"Here, you punk!"

The guy who heard my voice started running towards me again.

It was exactly in the direction of the traffic light I had crossed.

I slowly stepped back and checked the distance between us.

Come a little closer. Just a little closer.

The moment the guy finally crossed the crosswalk, the guy who had been charging like a mad bull suddenly stopped.

The guy's two eyes were looking straight at the traffic light.

For a moment, I was dumbfounded.

Damn, even that 'shark-head' obeys the signal?

Okay, then.

「This is a true story of how you can control the 'Traffic Light' of the Fear Realm at will.」

When I pressed the button on the remote control, the light of the traffic light changed to 'green'.

The guy started to cross the crosswalk as if he had been waiting. When he crossed the street, I didn't hesitate and pressed the button again. And then.

What I expected happened right before my eyes. With a flash of light, the day or the cost hit the guy.

Kudduk. Thump. Gwajijik.

A terrible bursting sound bursting out of the true body of the Outer God.

【Aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa】

I covered my ears and didn't take my eyes off the scene of the disaster. The guy's body was turning into rags in real time. Holes were drilled all over the giant shark's body and spines were sticking out. Broken canines and molars flew through the air.

But.

【Ooooooooooooooo】

The guy didn't die. It was coming towards me step by step without dying.

Tenacious and incredible vitality.

It seemed that this level of 'Fear' wouldn't be enough to kill the guy.

【Pick a toothpick...】

While running, I thought of a way to get rid of that Outer God, but no plausible method came to mind. For now, the best solution was to use the Fear hidden in the 'Fear Realm' to shake it off.

「There are three Fears I can use in the 'Fear Realm' Entrance Area.」

I counted the number of forks I had been running through so far.

「After passing the 'seven' forks in the entrance area, 'that place' appears.」

As expected, the 'fork' at the traffic light was exactly the 'seventh'.

In fact, after passing the last fork, the side road gradually felt wider.

I think I ran for a few hundred meters more.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is looking at you.]

There was a tunnel with an eerie light.

A Disaster-level Fear, the 'Festival Tunnel.'

It looked really unpleasant from the outside. Nevertheless, I had to go in there. That's because the 'Fear' I was looking for was inside that tunnel.

「There are seven 'Fears' hidden inside the 'Festival Tunnel'.」

This tunnel is a 'Fear that hides Fear'.

It was a Fear that simply hid other Fears.

I immediately activated [Way of the Wind] and ran towards the tunnel. As soon as I entered the tunnel entrance, the first Fear greeted me.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is chasing you!]

Then, small cracks began to spread on the floor.

A Catastrophe-level Fear, 「Race Cracks」.

This crack occurs the moment someone enters the tunnel. If you run slower than the spreading cracks, the floor of the tunnel will immediately collapse and swallow up the target.

Of course, the cracks could not be faster than me who activated [Way of the Wind].

When I ran about a hundred steps like that, some of the lights on the ceiling of the tunnel began to blink.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is watching you!]

A Catastrophe-level Fear, 「The lights that turn off the world.」

I calmly adjusted my running direction and avoided the lights.

You should never approach a place with a blinking light.

What happens if you do?

You disappear.

What happens after you disappear is not written in the 'Ways of Survival'.

Then I witnessed several more Fears.

A woman in a white dress loitering around the edge of the tunnel.

A bike rushed in from the opposite direction I was running in after a while.

I ignored it and continued running.

【This! This...】

Disaster-level Fear, 「War Air Defense.」

That was the name of the Fear I was looking for. This Fear was the only 「Safe Fear」 that the expedition team of the Fear Realm had found in the Entry Area, and it was the only one that provided absolute protection from external enemies as long as they were inside the air defense shelter.

However, the bunker's usage time is 3 hours.

After 3 hours, the user is forcibly ejected.

I planned to somehow get inside and buy time while thinking about the next operation.

However, the bunker was nowhere to be seen.

It was strange. 'Ways of Survival' clearly said it was around here.

Then, information flashed through my head.

「The expedition team was not safe in the last 3 Fear Realm Expeditions.」

What if there were strange signs in the 'Expedition' in this World Mountain?

So what if the Fears in the Fear Realm Entry Area were replaced by things I didn't know about?

So,

「What if the 'War Bunker' no longer exists?」

The sound of collision was heard right behind me. The hot breath of the shark-head tickled the back of my head.

The creature that even [Way of the Wind] couldn't shake off.

Cold sweat ran down my spine.

I couldn't die here.

I ran and ran. My breath was getting heavier and my magic was running out. My heart was throbbing because I was running so desperately.

Wait a minute. Heart?

Woohoohoo.

When did it start? The smartphone I had put in my coat pocket was ringing. It was a call.

I got goosebumps again.

Since I arrived in this world, not once has anyone called me. What kind of Unknown Fear is this?

However, the moment I checked the caller's name on the screen, I thought it was okay if it was a Fear.

「Second Kim Dokja」

I answered the phone.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 815 Episode 40 Fear Realm (7)

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I couldn't tell if what I was hearing was my heartbeat, voice, or the blood clot from the shark-head.

The call connected with a squelch-squelch sound. I was sure someone was hearing my voice on the other end of the line.

I screamed

"Please save me!"

Now that I was saying it, I felt a little embarrassed. Even so, just a few weeks ago, I was in a situation where I was being chased by the Historical-grade Constellations (not that it was my pure ability), I was being chased by the Narrative-grade Constellations (to be exact, it was the Demon King of Salvation), and I was being chased by <Olympus> and <Asgard> (this is true).

And yet I screamed for help just because of a shark-head?

"Please let me go!"

Is it really a matter of concern? If I do something wrong, I'll die.

"Hello? Kim Dokja-ssi? Can't you hear me? You called me!"

There was another noise through the phone with a tsk tsk.

Was the connection not working yet?

My heart was pounding.

"Second Kim Dokja! Second brother! No—"

First Kim Dokja—The Demon King of Salvation said. Every Kim Dokja has his own 'modifier'. That means that this second one also has a modifier that suits him.

And I already expected what that modifier would be.

"Light and Darkness—"

—Exhausted.

What?

—Heavy.

No, what is it all of a sudden?

—Sad.

I've received many calls in my life, but this was the first time someone had spoken like this.

I thought about the First's explanation about him. the Second was Kim Dokja, who understood sadness better than anyone else.

"Sad is that I'm about to die right now…"

—So I moved.

"Then please save me! Hurry up! Ugh, I'm going to get ripped apart!"

—Ugh. First, after dealing with Kim Dokja, I guess you have gained some inner strength.

Judging from the way he answered, I could guess what kind of Kim Dokja he was.

It seems that the personalities of the First and second sons of this damn Kim Dokja family are all twisted (which is only natural since they all originated from one soul).

"Please save me! Hurry up!"

I realized as I spoke. the Second won't save me. Because he's also a 'Kim Dokja'.

He must be talking about how sad and depressed he is, and he's happily watching my current situation-

—Yes

"Huh?"

—Turn to the right ten steps ahead. Then, put your hand on the tunnel wall.

I wanted to ask him if I would get my head eaten by the shark-head if I did that, but I had no other choice.

Exactly ten steps. I put my hand on the tunnel wall with the feeling of my sole sliding on the tunnel floor. Then.

Wow.

A faint green light began to glow on the tunnel wall.

"This is—"

I knew what it was.

[An 'Unknown Fear' is activated!]

[Disaster-level Fear — 'Sanctuary of the Brave' is activated.]

Sanctuary of the Brave.

It was right.

This was Chungmuro's hidden space, the hidden 'Green Zone'.

Why is this here?

Quaddudddudduk!

At the same time as the question, the head of the Outer God rushing toward me was crushed in the air.

【Eee eeee eeeeee】

The guy glared at me, dripping black blood. It seemed that even the power of that terrifying Outer God couldn't destroy this Safe Zone.

[Disaster-level Fear — 'Sanctuary of the Brave' protects you.]

[Nothing inside the tunnel can harm you for 20 minutes.]

A safe zone declared for 20 minutes.

It was surprising. Nowhere in the 'Ways or Survival' or even in the expedition team's records was this kind of Fear written.

But the Second Kim Dokja knew this place.

"Kim Dokja-ssi?"

—…

"Thank you."

In any case, the Second Kim Dokja saved me.

Maybe the Second is a good guy.

"I, in fact, the First Kim Dokja... I heard various stories from the 'Demon King of Salvation'."

—A depressing story.

"It wasn't a depressing story."

—A story about looking for me.

As expected, the Second Kim Dokja already knew why I came here.

I decided to be honest with him since it had come to this.

"Yes. I need your strength."

—…

"I know very well that the situation is very difficult."

Let's think. How can I persuade the 'Second Kim Dokja'?

I thought about the Second Kim Dokja for a moment. But I had nothing to think about. Because I didn't know much.

"Isn't this all because of the 'First'? Right?"

So I decided to sell off the 'Kim Dokja' that I already knew well.

"the First guy must have done something strange to make you hide here. He wants you to."

I don't know exactly why the Second Kim Dokja hid here.

I can only guess that it was caused by the incident that occurred when the 49% and 51% Kim Dokja fought over the disposal of the 41st world line.

"But listen, Second. If you hide here now, more people will be in trouble."

I don't know if the Second will be convinced by my words.

However, he is a Kim Dokja who 'empathizes well with sadness'.

So I thought that maybe this persuasion would work.

"If you've been watching, you know. There are readers who have forcibly possessed others in this world."

I thought of Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Cha Sungwoo, and Cha Yerin.

"Many readers have experienced terrible things just because they liked this story. Are you going to leave them alone? Is that one of the endings of the world you ultimately want?"

I know this is a rather cowardly way of talking. The readers possessed others, so it wasn't because of 'Second Kim Dokja'.

"Please lend me your strength. Please help me save them."

Even so, I had to take them hostage. I had to persuade Second Kim Dokja this way.

"So that I can write the ending that I want, that you like..."

—I.

The voice of the Second son on the other end of the phone was truly sad. It was the voice of a person who had been crushed by a sadness, that I could not even fathom, for a very long time.

—I live in a very big house.

"Yes?"

—That's why I can't help you.

Before I could ask what he meant, the Second continued.

—Go back. Before the Recorders notice.

Recorders. I realized that it was referring to the 'Recorder of Fear'.

The moment I was about to ask about it, the Second added.

—Don't try to change this world.

That was the end of the call. With a beep, the call ended.

I blankly looked down at the screen and pressed the call button again.

Beep—beep—

The call was not connected. It felt as if the line with the Second had been cut off.

I reviewed the words of the Second again with a complicated mind.

—I live in a very big house. That's why I can't help you.

What on earth could that mean? Is it a metaphor for the cost, or… maybe.

['Sanctuary of the Brave' has 15 minutes left to last.]

For a brief moment, an imagination flashed through my mind, but I soon shook my head.

Surely not.

'Big house' couldn't mean that.

I pressed the call button several times after that, but the line still wouldn't connect.

['Sanctuary of the Brave' has 14 minutes left to last.]

Now, there were 14 minutes left.

A shark-head that had curled up about a meter away was staring at me. It seemed like the guy knew the principle of this 'Green Zone'.

I guess he was planning to attack me as soon as this 'Safe Zone' was lifted.

I bit my lip and looked down at my smartphone again. Unless Jaehwan-ssi suddenly showed up here, the only way for me to escape this situation was with this 'smartphone'.

Now that I think about it, why is 'Second Kim Dokja's' contact information saved on this phone?

I hastily checked my call log and contact list. And I checked the person I had just called at the top of the contact list.

—Second Kim Dokja.

Even when I looked again, it was definitely saved as 'Second Kim Dokja'.

There was a note below the contact that said:

| |
|---|
| Always sad. |

It was clear who had left that note.

It occurred to me later that this ‘smartphone’ was the relic of the 'Demon King of Salvation'. The person who had saved this 'Second Kim Dokja' contact was the First Kim Dokja—in other words, the Demon King of Salvation himself.

There wasn’t even just one contact.

—Third Kim Dokja

I doubted my eyes for a moment.

No, it was this easy to contact each other as Kim Dokja?

The note written below the third person’s contact was:

Always lazy.

Lazy?

I hesitated for a moment and pressed the call button.

I honestly thought that whether he was lazy or sad, his personality was the main issue. The person I need right now is 'Kim Dokja' who will help me.

Although the Demon King of Salvation told me to find the 'Second' first, if I think about it, there's no need to insist on the Second, right?

Tsk tsk tsk!

I almost dropped the phone call, startled by the current flowing through my ears. The call didn't go through. Does this mean that the probability is not possible? Or is the Third simply lazy and not answering the phone?

In either case, it was clear that the Third couldn't be reached either.

Then all that was left was…

—Me

That was the last name saved in my contacts.

I thought about the meaning of that word for a moment and pressed the call button.

The smartphone I have now belongs to the 'Demon King of Salvation' himself. So who would be answering the phone when I call 'me'?

After a short beep, someone answered the phone.

—You heard my curse, Youngest.

It was a voice that was both annoying and welcome.

---

"Wow, was it this easy to contact you?"

—This is the Fear Realm. This was also recognized as a kind of 'Fear'. Do you think breaking the [Fourth Wall] is that easy?

Was he happy to have a long-awaited conversation?

In a short time, I told the Eldest Kim Dokja everything that had happened up until now and what had just happened.

The Eldest Kim Dokja—the former Demon King of Salvation listened to me for a moment and then answered as follows.

—The Third one doesn't answer the phone well. That guy keeps putting it on airplane mode. It's been a long time since I've made a call.

From what I've heard, it seems like all the Kim Dokjas have a 'smartphone', a sacred relic.

—By the way, is that what the Second one said? A big house?

"Yes, is there a part where he can't do it?"

—Hmm. Then the situation gets a bit serious.

"Why?"

—For now, let's take care of your situation.

['Sanctuary of the Brave' has 5 minutes left to maintain.]

Now, there are only 5 minutes left to maintain the safe zone. There's a monster shark targeting my stories right in front of me, and I have no way to deal with it.

—There really is no way?

"Actually, there is."

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' nods.]

Kim Dokja doesn't say things like 'there is no way'. Because that's the kind of person he is. He always knows a way that no one else knows, and if there's no way, he'll find a way by any means necessary. And I was the youngest of those Kim Dokjas.

"There are about three ways."

Kim Dokja muttered as if he was in awe.

—Now you're following all the other paths.

"One way. I can become Shin Yoosung by using [Incite]."

Kim Dokja thought for a moment and then asked back.

—Your world's Yoosoung is still weak. And even if you use [Incite], you can't get that character's skills, right?

"It's different for characters with high comprehension. It's possible to get some skills or characteristics with [Incite]. It's only for a short time and it doesn't last as long as [Bookmark], but."

—[Incite] can do that?

It can. In fact, I became 'Shin Yoosung who tamed Queen Mirabad' in 'The Field of Nagak' in that way.

I'm much stronger now than then, so I should be able to transform into a stronger Shin Yoosung. Even if I become the 'Beast Lord', it shouldn't be a problem if I become 'Beast Lord' Shin Yoosung.

"However, there are some side effects, so I'll live thinking I'm really that person for a while."

—That's terrible. What are you going to do if you become Yoosoung?

"I'm going to tame Outer Gods' spirits."

—Will that work?

It won't work. Actually, I knew it wouldn't work. However, even Kim Dokja always says the first method is impossible. It's Kim Dokja's law.

—Right from the third one.

"the second method is to use 'Thousand-Billed Manhwa Jang Haengbok' with 'Thought' to become a dwarf."

—What are you going to do after becoming a dwarf?

"Go into that guy's stomach."

—Aha, getting eaten yourself is the second method?

"That's where it gets important. What would happen if an Outer God were to eat me?"

—Wait. You.

"Do you remember what happened to the 'Dream Eater'?"

Of course, I would take a fatal blow to my incarnation body during the process of being swallowed, but I'll become a 'dwarf' to reduce the damage.

Once I get into that guy's stomach, other skills will take care of the rest, not me.

That's what the [Fourth Wall] is.

"I happen to have a [Fourth Wall], and that Outer God is a guy who wants to eat Kim Dokja like the 'Dream Eater' back then. Everything is perfect."

—You really only think of methods like mine.

"Because I'm the Demon King of Salvation right now."

Actually, the second method was the best method I had imagined.

But Kim Dokja seemed to have a different opinion.

—That won't work.

"Why?"

—Then that shark bastard will also enter the [Fourth Wall].

By the way, the First Kim Dokja was currently inside the [Fourth Wall] I had created.

"You can just live together."

—No. Do you know how good this is? Now, tell me the third method.

"I need your help with the third method."

—Me? You want me to descend or something?

"Can you?"

—No.

"I didn't expect it."

Actually, even if I did, I wouldn't ask. I finally got to hear his voice, but if I do something like that, I might lose the probability and never see him again.

What I wanted to ask was something else.

—Drawing?

"Please help me find some information."

—Information? What information?

"I need information about that shark-head. Aren't you inside the [Fourth Wall] right now?"

The essence of the [Fourth Wall] is a 'library'.

Inside it are the records and history of countless 'Ways of Survival' that Kim Dokja has read.

—Well, that's right. If I knew, the [Fourth Wall] would be a bit different.

But that's the main story, and the [Fourth Wall] that I restored for the kkoma Kim Dokjas were much more incomplete and smaller.

—But as you know, there aren't that many records here. It's not a complete [Fourth Wall].

"I know. But the information I'm looking for will be there."

At least as long as the [Fourth Wall] contains the 'history of Kim Dokja', and as long as I'm a part of that 'Kim Dokja'— the 'record' I'm looking for is definitely there.

"The information I need is the 'Discarded Setting Collection'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 816 Episode 40 Fear Realm (8)

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First Kim Dokja left a message telling me to wait a moment and disappeared. It seemed that he was searching the [Fourth Wall].

[There are 3 minutes left for the 'Sanctuary of the Brave'.]

Outside the safe zone, there was a shark-head crouching quietly and glaring at me.

「Discarded Setting Collection」

If my guess is correct, the 'Fears' of this 'Fear Realm' may be discarded or unused settings.

Just look at this 'Sanctuary of the Brave'. Even when I was writing the serial version, the 'Hidden Green Zone' located on the wall of the middle room did not have its own name.

In other words, 'Sanctuary of the Brave' was a 'setting name' that had not yet been used.

If this inference is correct, the 'shark-head' in front of me was also likely one of those settings.

「But is this guy really in my discarded settings?」

I made and deleted so many settings that I couldn't remember clearly, but it was true that there was a folder called 'Discarded Settings'.

It was a folder that mainly contained settings that had been censored by Ji Eunyu, and I thought that if the [Fourth Wall] really was a library that kept the 'records' of Kim Dokja, then those records would also exist.

[There is 1 minute left for 'Sanctuary of the Brave'.]

Kim Dokja still hadn't contacted me.

After thinking for a moment, I prepared myself and pulled out 'Thought'.

「Turn into a Cheonbyeon Manhwa's sleeping suit.」

I didn't tell Kim Dokja, but in fact, I was planning to stick to the 'second method' I mentioned earlier.

「Intentionally getting eaten by the shark head so that the [Fourth Wall] activates.」

Even if the 'Discarded Settings' really did exist, there might not be that 'shark-head' entry. Above all, even if that item existed, I wondered if I could overcome this situation with just a few lines of description.

In short, asking Kim Dokja to find the 'Discarded Settings' was a kind of trick.

If he was watching me, he would definitely disturb me.

But now, I could get eaten without anyone disturbing me.

['Sanctuary of the Brave' has 30 seconds left.]

I broke out in a cold sweat as I thought that the guy's fangs would soon pierce me.

No matter how much the [Fourth Wall] exists, it is not without pain. Wounds are bitter and death is still scary.

The moment I stood up after making up my mind over and over again.

['Sanctuary of the Brave' has 20 seconds left.]

A phone call came.

—Youngest, I found it.

"Was it really there?"

—Then did you think it wasn't there?

But now there were only 10 seconds left.

There was not enough time.

—But the title is a bit different from what you said?

"The title is different?"

My mind became complicated for a moment.

Have I ever made another setting book?

No matter how hard I tried, I couldn’t remember.

—Oh, but it’s definitely written about Fear. There’s also some information I haven’t read yet, and I actually want to read it first…

"Shark-Head! Is there an explanation about the shark-head?"

[The effect of 'Sanctuary of the Brave' disappears.]

The 'Safe Zone' was disappearing before my eyes.

The shark-head that had been crouching opened its mouth as if it had been waiting.

—There.

A screen appeared on the LCD along with Kim Dokja’s voice. It was a screen with information related to 'Shark-Head'.

[Your exclusive trait is activated.]

With a feeling of time slowing down for a moment, I began to read the letters on the LCD.

* Part of this document was modified by SVRP.

SVRP. PW 00843.

Disaster-level Fear — Tooth fin

An Outer God that has reigned over the seas as a Fear for a long time.

A Fear fusion occurred over time immediately after birth. The result of the re-examination of the individual's legend wavelength confirmed a 'chimera' transformation.

…

Continuous worship phenomenon observed from the 8612th planetary system.

An 'Outer God' occurred 1,024 years after birth. The level was adjusted from to 'Disaster-level'.

…

Uses 'Gyo-a-byeong' made from its own fangs and molars as its main weapon.

In some rounds, after obtaining ■■■■, there were cases where the individual went beyond 'Fear'.

During the '2nd Murim Destruction Scenario', the individual's level was temporarily adjusted to 'Natural Disaster-level'.

…

Basically, it has a gentle personality, and except for some extreme cases, it rarely attacks people. The actual risk level was set at less than a Catastrophe.

Is it because of Kim Dokja's characteristics? It took less than a second to read all of that.

But one line of question remained.

「The shark-head is basically 'gentle'.」

That part was the most incomprehensible. Because the 'shark-head' I saw wasn't as gentle as described in the records.

「Then why is this 'shark-head' chasing me?」

The reason was also in the records.

For some reason, the records were damaged by ■, but it wasn't that hard to guess.

[Exclusive characteristic 'Lamarck's Giraffe' activates!]

If everything goes as I thought, there's only one way to break the current situation.

—Youngest! You...!

Kim Dokja shouted as he realized what I was trying to do.

The shark-head opened its mouth right in front of me — the inside of the mouth was completely covered with sharp fangs. The moment those fangs approached and tried to tear me apart, I barely managed to pull out a story fragment from deep inside my body.

"You're looking for this, right?"

A story was fluttering in my hand.

[Story fragment 'Rapid Swim' shudders.]

That must be it. The reason the guy chased me was because of this 'story fragment'.

The fragment that Jaehwan obtained when he defeated another 'shark god'.

—Youngest, are you crazy?

I know. It would be hard to change his mind even if I gave him this now. Still, it was worth a try.

I thought of the traffic light.

The Fear marked as 'a long-necked object' and 'a white ladder'. When I first encountered those symbols, I didn't know that it was a 'traffic light'.

The unknown is scary.

All Fear operates based on that ignorance.

The shark in front of me might be the same.

「Basically, it has a gentle nature,」

What I should believe now is not a sense soaked in Fear, but a dry 'record'.

For example, the history of this entity's life.

「Except for some extreme cases, there are almost no cases of it attacking people.」

Born worshiped on Earth, hated by all, and reigning as a Fear in the sea, 'Tooth Fin'.

I held out the fragment of the story 「Rapid Swim」 toward it.

"I don't know what this means to you, but."

I said while looking at the eerie mouth of the Outer God.

"I'll give it back."

I erased my preconceptions one by one, as if I was erasing letters by pressing backspace.

Instead, I carefully examined the shark-like entity's mouth, fins, and the stitches left here and there. And I imagined the histories that must have been piled up between those wounds.

Just like when Shin Yoosung first tamed the 'Chimera Dragon'.

This entity is not scary. It doesn't hurt people unless you touch it first.

The Outer God seemed to sense something and thrust its snout toward my hand.

Hot steam flowed out of its nose.

For a moment, I felt like I would lose my mind due to the indescribable stench of contaminated stories. But I held on.

Just the fact that the thing didn't attack me right away seemed possible.

Just a little more, just a little more—

[A new Fear has been unlocked!]

And finally, the Tooth Fin's mouth bit my hand.

[Cataclysmic Fear—'Tooth Fin' takes hostility from you.]

I felt the story fragment wrapped around my fingertips disappear as it touched something damp.

[A new interpretation of the Fear has been acquired!]

[Interpretation suggestion: Do not judge by the fin.]

[The Fear Realm accepts your interpretation!]

[The Fear Realm's Exploration level increases greatly!]

…

[You will receive a new 'Story Fragment' as a reward!]

The expression of the Outer God changed bizarrely along with the message pouring out of the air. It looked like it was smiling, but it also looked sad. With that face, the guy left the tunnel with the story fragment in his mouth.

I followed the guy to the end of the tunnel. The guy was endlessly glaring at the pitch-black emptiness of the Fear Realm.

And soon, a bright light came out from his entire body. A few mournful cries echoed. The Outer God swung its dorsal fins and floated above our heads in a large circle.

Kim Dokja and I quietly looked up at the dreamy dance of the Outer God.

—It was solved this easily?

"Did it seem easy?"

Kim Dokja said nothing. In fact, both of us knew that it wasn’t that easy.

—How did you know?

"Back."

—That guy wasn’t a shark.

Kim Dokja’s guess was right. That Outer God was not a 'shark'. It resembled a shark's head and had a shark's dorsal fin on its back, but it was definitely not a shark.

A long, bursting cry.

The dorsal fin of the wiggling creature showed an elaborate suture line.

—Did you see that?

"Yes."

I guess the original form of that Outer God was not a shark but a 'whale'.

I don't know what kind of history it has, but it certainly seemed to be related to the 'Shark Outer God' that Jaehwan killed.

The dorsal fin of the sewn-up creature could have been that of a shark Outer God.

The fragment of the story I gave it, 「Rapid Swim」, might not have belonged to the Outer God I gave it to.

Thinking about it that way, the dance of the creature spinning around in the air felt like a kind of memorial service.

A mourning ritual for an old friend.

"Constellation-ssi."

—Uh.

"This book."

I looked down at the 'Fear Setting Collection' that Kim Dokja had found in the [Fourth Wall].

"Who wrote it?"

This document was not the 'Discarded Setting Collection' that I had requested. The sentences and the structure were different from my narrative style.

I read the document on 'Tooth Fin' once again.

The sentences were written so dryly, as if they were conscious of someone, and were listed in such unnecessary detail.

My heart ached and pounded every time I read them.

Every sentence in this document was telling me. I was not the one who wrote this document.

—Who do you think wrote it?

"I want to read the first sentence."

After a while, a file that Kim Dokja had sent appeared on the screen.

I opened the file with trembling hands.

The moment I saw the title, I chuckled.

Kim Dokja must have had the same expression.

『A Guide to Fear That Even a Squid and Sunfish Can Understand』.

I don't know why this book was inside the [Fourth Wall], but at least one thing was certain.

Kim Dokja and I both know.

There is only one writer in this universe who gives a book title like this.

"As expected!"

—I told you.

She is alive somewhere.

「Han Sooyoung」

Still writing a story for just one reader.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 817 Episode 41 Sophistry (1)

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「A story exists only because everything cannot be recorded.」

Things that cannot be told disappear outside the scenario, and sometimes they appear in the universe in unfamiliar forms.

They are commonly called Otherworldly Deities, or Outer Gods.

But no name can contain their sorrow, so the recorders call them Fear.」

—Recorder of Fear

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Snowflakes fell on his face and melted warmly. Gilyoung opened his eyes at the soft sensation.

"Hyung."

As soon as he opened his eyes, a pure white snowy field spread out before him. At the end of the snowy field, the person the boy had been longing for was standing. A person who waved his slender arms lightly, a person whose lonely smile was truly charming.

He smiled as brightly as always, and disappeared into the snow that was as white as his face.

"Dokja hyung!"

A name he thought he would never be able to call again. Gilyoung called it out loud.

"Kim Dokja!"

Memories that came to mind.

「He came here to find Kim Dokja.」

In order to meet that person again, to reunite with each other in complete form, the group chose one ending.

They collected his pieces from the ashen ruins where there was nothing. They accepted the tragedy of participating in the scenarios again.

They went to the recycling center.

"Dokja hyung! Dokja hyung!"

When they first saw him, Lee Gilyoung denied that he was Kim Dokja. He thought that he couldn't call him 'Kim Dokja' simply because he shared a part of his memories.

「To Lee Gilyoung, Kim Dokja was the main character and a god.」

The Kim Dokja he remembered was an omniscient man. A man who knew everything and always made choices that defied people's expectations.

A man who could give a grasshopper to an insignificant boy in the midst of the subway tragedy where everyone was killing each other.

Kim Dokja was that kind of person.

「That's why the '41st Round' was too weak to become Kim Dokja.」

He resembled Kim Dokja's face and speech, but no matter how you looked at him, he was a weak person who couldn't protect the moon alone.

Lee Gilyoung always watched him from the shadow of the scenarios, afraid that he might die.

The more he looked, the more different he was from Kim Dokja.

He saved people without knowing that he was dying, and fought for people who weren't worth keeping alive, and he couldn't even do anything about the scenario right in front of him, but only looked into the distant future with his eyes.

After all, that's not Dokja hyung.

While thinking that to himself, Lee Gilyoung continued to watch his story.

He watched him slowly make his way through the scenario, and he saw the number of people following him increase one by one.

Watching his story, which took a strangely different path from the path that <Kim Dokja Company> had walked, Lee Gilyoung often had a thought.

「Was Dokja hyung a strong person from the beginning?」

The Kim Dokja in his memories was a complete person from the beginning.

A person who held all the world's records in his hands. But was Kim Dokja really that kind of person? Wasn't that actually an illusion he had created?

Maybe Dokja hyung also wanted to run away every time.

He might not have wanted to fight.

He might have been afraid of death.

It must have been more difficult for him than anyone else to pioneer a new path that no one had walked before.

「"Just wait a little."」

Even so, Kim Dokja always fought with the illusions of his companions on his back.

He is the omniscient Kim Dokja.

He is the Kim Dokja who always has to sacrifice alone.

Lee Gilyoung hated Kim Dokja who tried to handle everything alone. He hoped that he wouldn't make sacrifices. He hoped that he wouldn't be left alone. Even so.

Or perhaps because of that,

「"I'm going to write that sentence from now on."」

When the man made the same choice as that 'Kim Dokja', Lee Gilyoung had no choice but to admit it.

"Don't go! Don't do it!"

That person is Kim Dokja.

"Please! Don't do it!"

The Kim Dokja he was looking for was always the Kim Dokja who left him. In that irony, Gilyoung shouted and shouted at the disappearing figure of Kim Dokja.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its storytelling again.]

I must not let that story be recorded. I must not let Kim Dokja die again.

The moment he reached out to him again.

「"You've worked hard. You'll go back now."」

The answer that came back was that of the supervisor.

He was the old man who brought Gilyoung to the 'Recycling Center.'

"No."

Gilyoung growled and snapped. He still hadn't done his job. He hadn't saved his hyung from another world.

However, the head of the Recycling Center—the 'Mass Producer'—had shook his head.

「"The story between him and you is already over."」

"What nonsense are you talking about."

Their story wasn't over.

Kim Dokja was still his main character and the god of this world.

「"Didn't Han Sooyoung already conclude the story where he was the main character?"」

The moment he heard those words, Han Sooyoung suddenly came to mind. Yes. Han Sooyoung was there.

She might be able to do it. She could change all these records.

But this time, the Mass Producer shook his head.

「"Another story has already begun."」

Lee Gilyoung wanted to ask what that meant.

He is still here.

<Kim Dokja Company> is still looking for Kim Dokja. So the story is not over. Their roles continue.

「"You, don’t you know anything yet?"」]

The mass-producer felt sorry for Lee Gilyoung and reached out and touched his cheek.

「"No, maybe it would be better to continue not knowing."」

When he opened his eyes again, he saw a pure white snowy field. When he looked closely, it was the ceiling of the hospital room.

He felt something flowing down the corner of his eye. At first glance, a hand that felt indifferent wiped away his tears.

"Idiot. Are you awake?"

When he turned his head, Shin Yoosung was looking at him. Lee Gilyoung looked up at the girl with blank eyes. The boy and girl looked at each other for a long time.

Lee Gilyoung said.

"We failed."

This time, the two children failed to save Kim Dokja.

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<Kim Dokja Company> gathered together for the first time.

"Gilyoung. Don't you have something to say to the people?"

Lee Gilyoung was called out by Yoo Sangah's words. The boy sighed deeply as he endured the gazes of the group looking at him.

"C-Can't we do it later? My limbs are so numb right now, and my neck hurts a little..."

It wasn't a lie. Lee Gilyoung suffered damage to various parts of his body due to the effects of the aftershock of the probability.

Fortunately, Abaddon, his sponsor, had taken some of the aftershock, so it wasn't a wound that could have killed him.

However, this time, he couldn't make excuses about being sick.

"This time, you're not the only one who got hurt."

Hearing Yoo Sangah's cold voice for the first time in a long time, Gilyoung shrugged his shoulders and looked around at the group.

Yoo Sangah, Lee Seolhwa, Shin Yoosung, and that dark guy… No one seemed particularly hurt.

Could it be that they were hurt?

"Oh really, just forgive me. The kid got into an accident."

Someone was coming in through the creaking door to the hospital room.

Shin Yoosung, startled, got up from her seat and supported the person, who was staggering.

"Unni, what should I do if you come out already?"

"Oh, why? I'm okay. I'm all better."

"What's better? Seolhwa said earlier that you need to rest—"

Gilyoung opened his eyes in surprise.

Lee Jihye was waving her right hand while her whole body was wrapped in bandages.

"Unni?"

"What."

"No, why all those bandages?"

"What."

She can wrap bandages. But the problem was that she had bandages all over her body, or more precisely, the fact that she was 'bandaged' was the problem.

There were countless ways to treat wounds in this world. There was a medicine that would completely heal the wound the next day if you took one pill and fell asleep, and there was an ointment that would quickly regenerate new skin if you just lightly applied it.

Despite the existence of such items, Lee Jihye was wearing bandages. This meant that her injury could not be treated without bandaging.

"Why are you all looking at me like that? I'm really okay. I'm fine."

Lee Jihye, who was saying that, seemed to have difficulty raising both arms. After a moment of struggling and receiving criticism from Shin Yoosung, Lee Jihye slumped down on her chair and continued speaking.

"Don't be so mean to him, everyone. It's okay for a child to have an accident. That's how they grow up."

Only then did Lee Gilyoung realize why Lee Jihye was so hurt. Before he knew it, his hands were covered in cold sweat. He bit his lips. If it were normal, he would have snapped, "No, who would have come to save you for so long?" but this time, he couldn’t say that. Even at a glance, Lee Jihye’s wounds looked really serious.

"Noona..."

Lee Jihye giggled at Lee Gilyoung’s unusual attitude.

"Hey, it’s really nothing. It’s just that I didn’t fight well because it’s been a while."

"…Who did that?"

"Why? If you know, you’ll take revenge on them."

"Tell me."

"The Spear That Draws the Boundary of the Seas."

"Poseidon."

Lee Gilyoung bit his lips.

Lee Jihye coughed lightly and laughed, wiping her nose.

"Hey, but isn't it a good thing that I fought Poseidon to this extent? Even so, he's still the 3rd god of <Olympus>."

"…"

"I told you I couldn't move with [Ghost Fleet]? I shot hundreds of rounds per second while changing the story, and that old man's expression turned pale and—"

Lee Gilyoung couldn't raise his drooping head.

He wanted to ask. Why did she come all this way to save him?

He wanted to tell her. It would have been okay if she hadn't come. He would have somehow come back alive.

She didn't have to get hurt like that.

"Gilyoung, I know what you're thinking."

Lee Jihye spoke to Lee Gilyoung. With her bandaged hands, she wrapped her arms around the boy's shoulders, who had grown quite a bit.

"I was just like you."

Lee Jihye looked at the group in place of the proud boy. And she bowed her head, creaking with her unbending back.

"So I'm sorry."

As Lee Jihye apologized on his behalf, something inside Lee Gilyoung that he had been holding back burst out. Lee Gilyoung, who had gotten up with a jerk, fell to his knees on the floor.

"I was wrong. I'm sorry for worrying you. I'm really, really sorry."

Lee Seolhwa sat the children down, who were apologizing repeatedly.

"Calm down, both of you. Have a drink of this each."

There was no one there who blamed the children. Not Yoo Sangah, not Lee Seolhwa, not Yoo Joonghyuk.

In fact, they all knew. They would have acted the same way if they were in the children's shoes.

"It's okay since they're alive."

The one who said those words was Yoo Joonghyuk.

The fact that Yoo Joonghyuk said those words was enough to make the group look at him in surprise.

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned and added.

"So let's stop talking about unnecessary things. I want to hear why we're here."

Yoo Sangah nodded.

In fact, they didn't gather here just to call the kids and scold them. There was something much more important.

"I have two pieces of news."

"Say it."

"One is news about Heewon and Hyunsung."

Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsung, the children gulped at the familiar names they had finally heard.

"I think the two have finally made up their minds."

Determination.

The group's expressions brightened at Yoo Sangah's expression.

The first to speak was Shin Yoosung.

"Are Hyunsung and Heewon-unnie here too?"

"Where are they? The two of them—"

However, no matter how much they looked around, they couldn't see the two of them. No matter how much they raised their alertness or sharpened their senses, they couldn't feel any sign of them.

"Ah."

With Shin Yoosung's sigh, the group realized.

Just as they chose their 'ending', the other two also chose their 'ending'.

Yoo Sangah nodded and said.

"The two went to a 'different ending' than us."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 818 Episode 41 Sophistry (2)

Lee Hyunsung and Jung Heewon.

The two chose a 'different ending' from the others. It was obvious what ending they chose.

The two would head to 'the world where Kim Dokja is'.

Lee Jihye licked her lips.

"Then...we won't be able to see each other anymore?"

Yoo Sangah hesitated for a moment before answering.

"It's not certain. It's similar to the fact that the world line branched off. We might meet again.

"That's not certain either, is it?"

Yoo Sangah didn't answer.

Lee Jihye muttered, accepting the silence as affirmation.

"If we had made that choice..."

"Then we wouldn't have met the ahjussi of the 41st Round."

Shin Yoosung's strong voice cut off Lee Jihye's words.

"Heewon-unnie and Hyunsung-ahjussi chose the best for themselves, and we chose the best for ourselves."

No one in the group blamed Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsung. Rather, they hoped that they would be happy for having made different choices.

The fact that each of the group chose different endings was simply a matter of how they understood Kim Dokja. The 'Kim Dokja' they chose was different, but the fact that they all liked Kim Dokja remained the same.

"Maybe that's the same for Dokja ahjussi."

The group responded to Shin Yoosung's words. They all stared at the screen on the wall. The records of the 'Recycling Center' were flowing out on the screen.

Now, the 41st Kim Dokja, who has become the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

His squinted eyes, which made it impossible to tell what he wanted to see or where he was looking, were reflected all over the screen.

Lee Jihye muttered.

"If that's ahjussi's choice and the world he wanted to see..."

Even without saying more, everyone already knew what she would say next.

"Maybe we're characters who don't fit in this story."

The one who broke the deep, short silence that had fallen for a moment was Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You're still saying such pathetic things. I'm not curious about what kind of story he wants to see."

"Why is the master trying to intervene in that story?"

"Let's find that guy who made things so complicated..."

Is it because Yoo Joonghyuk has changed a little now that he doesn't say until the end that he will kill him?

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned as if he didn't like the original price and looked back at Yoo Sangah and urged her.

"What about the second news? Didn't you say you have two things to tell us?"

She already said one piece of news. The whereabouts of Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsoung.

But there was still one more thing left.

Instead of telling the remaining one right away, Yoo Sangah looked at the group and said this.

"I also agree with what Joonghyuk-ssi said. I respect the life of Dokja-ssi, but I think it's too early for us to give up."

"Do you think we still have a role to play, Unnie?"

"I don't know about that..."

Yoo Sangah continued speaking while looking at the squinted eyes of Kim Dokja, who was slowly growing bigger in the 41st Round.

"If this world is the dream that Dokja-ssi is dreaming, I think there must be a place for us too. I don’t know if it’s a villain or a good guy.”

"If it’s Sooyoung, I think she’ll use us as villains."

Lee Seolhwa added cheerfully, and the group smiled bitterly.

Yoo Sangah nodded and continued.

"The second news is about Han Sooyoung."

“Is Sooyoung awake?”

Han Sooyoung hadn’t woken up since fighting the Outer God to save Kim Dokja in the 41st Round.

"Not yet."

"Really? Where is Sooyoung right now?"

"I don’t know exactly, but… It seems certain that something happened to Sooyoung."

Yoo Sangah took out her notebook from her bosom. Everyone here knew what the notebook was.

It was Han Sooyoung's notebook.

Han Sooyoung used it to write the story of Kim Dokja and <Kim Dokja Company>.

At the moment when the eyes of the group were filled with longing, Yoo Sangah, who had picked up the notebook, opened a file.

The story of Kim Dokja that Han Sooyoung had written some time ago.

Familiar letters that they hadn't seen in a long time were unfolding before their eyes.

"Huh?"

But the condition of the manuscript was strange.

「■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■…」

The content was covered in noise.

"W-why is it like this all of a sudden? Is the computer broken?"

It wasn't just a feeling of a breakdown. Yoo Joonghyuk said, checking the sparks fluttering faintly on the manuscript.

"The story is contaminated."

Story contamination. It was a symptom that often appeared in old stories. The context of the story becomes tangled or parts are lost.

But what does it mean that the contamination occurred in this manuscript of all things?

"When did it start like this?"

"Since the start of the 41st Round."

"What caused it?"

Yoo Sangah sighed lightly at Yoo Joonghyuk's question and opened her mouth.

"From now on, it's my hypothesis, so don't take it too seriously."

"Tell me."

"You all know how this world works, right?"

Lee Jihye nodded, scratching her cheek.

"Well, Sooyoung-unnie explained it to me once before..."

"I heard that Sooyoung-unnie wrote about Joonghyuk-ssi, and that Dokja read it, and that's how the world came to exist. Isn't it?"

Lee Jihye tilted her head at Shin Yoosung's words.

"Then does that mean that Sooyoung wrote the book first and that this world existed?"

"No. Sooyoung went back in time and wrote the book based on the things that happened with Dokja-hyung, so Dokja-hyung read it first."

"What are you talking about? How can he read a book that no one wrote?"

"He can read it because he's a god."

Yoo Sangah said, stopping the bickering children.

"There's no point in measuring who's late and who's early. As you know, this world is made so that you can't tell the beginning and the end."

One day, Han Sooyoung said something similar.

This world is a 'square circle'.

A world that exists only as a 'text' that humans cannot imagine, with a continuity that is impossible in terms of time and space.

"So what does that mean?"

"A story that starts later can be placed on a faster timeline."

A story that starts later can be faster. The group already knew the example of that.

"Like Joonghyuk’s 1,863rd round."

"The story of Kim Dokja, who existed after the 'Ways of Survival', changing Yoo Joonghyuk's last round."

Lee Seolhwa nodded as if she understood.

"Is something similar happening in the 41st Round right now?"

"That's right. To be exact..."

Yoo Sangah scrolled down and turned the pages of the manuscript.

Chapter 1, chapter 2, chapter 3, chapter 4…

The pages that kept turning stopped at some point.

Chapter 551. That was the last chapter of Kim Dokja and <Kim Dokja Company> written by Han Sooyoung, and the end of that world.

But the moment she turned the next manuscript.

"Huh?"

A page that had never existed before appeared.

The bewildered group asked.

"Wait a minute. What is this?"

The manuscript that had clearly been blank after the conclusion was filled in with letters.

Yoo Sangah said.

"The story of the 41st Round is being written."

"Is Sooyoung-unnie writing the latter part?"

Even the manuscript was being written and erased repeatedly.

If Han Sooyoung had said that she would always be a writer for one person, there was a possibility that she was continuing to write this manuscript somewhere.

"Some parts seem to have been written by Sooyoung. But not all parts are like that."

"There was someone else who wrote the manuscript besides Sooyoung?"

"When you read it, the writing style is not consistent in each part. The theme is also subtly different. I don't know how to express it exactly, but..."

Yoo Sangah paused for a moment to think about her words before opening her mouth again.

"It looks like several writers are competing over a single manuscript."

Yoo Joonghyuk thought for a moment and asked.

"Who and why did they do that?"

"I don't know that much, but this is what I think."

Yoo Sangah read the latest sentences that were being written in real time.

Looking at the lines being written in real time, Yoo Sangah thought.

Is this something she's writing because she's saying it? Or is it something she's saying because it's already been written?

"There are people who want to steal the 'stories' we've built."

It didn't matter either way.

What was certain was that this gave her and <Kim Dokja Company> something to do.

"To be exact, I'm talking about 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 written by Sooyoung."

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【Do you really think he's qualified to be a 'Recorder'?】

---

I read Han Sooyoung's 『Guide to Fear Spirits That Even a Squid and Sunfish Can Understand』 with Kim Dokja.

As the title suggests, It was a 'setting book' written in easy-to-understand sentences.

However, there was one catch.

For example.

> *Viewing this document has been prohibited by SVRP.
>
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> ■■ ■■■ ■
>
> ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■…

Similar traces remained throughout the book. It felt as if multiple editors had intervened in a single manuscript and modified or deleted parts here and there.

— It seems like someone edited the manuscript written by Han Sooyoung.

Kim Dokja had a similar opinion.

The question is who would do such a thing.

Of course, we had a hard time guessing the answer.

— They must probably be someone who records 'Fear'.

「Recorder of Fear.」

But why did they touch Han Sooyoung's manuscript?

Why was this manuscript in [Fourth Wall] in the first place?

As of now, there were almost no clues that could be guessed. Since there were no clues, it was time to read what we could find out

—Though there was no time to read everything.

"But let's take a look at the basics one by one."

If Kim Dokja was next to me, he would have smiled his signature grin. I could picture it. We are the second-best type addicts in this universe, so

"What should we check first?"

—We need to first examine which Fears are weak and which are strong.

"If we don't want to die."

That's what I said, but in fact, there was another reason.

Who are we? Aren't we just fragments of Kim Dokja, who drew 'Ways of Survival Power Balance Diagrams' during every break?

According to the 'Guide to Fear Spirits that Even a Squid and SunfishCan Understand', the 'Fear' of Fear Spirits is broadly defined into four levels.

Fear of a Catastrophe.

Fear of a Disaster.

Fear of a Natural Disaster.

Fear of the End.

The 'Traffic Lights' and 'Uniformity' of that I encountered before are the most primitive Fears.

It was a 'Catastrophe-level'.

「Catastrophe-level Fear refers to 'Fear' that regularly causes deaths of at least 0 to 50 people.」

「The cause of Catastrophe-level Fear is mainly a mutated Narrative-grade 'Story'.」

"It was based on a story after all."

It was only then that the overall picture of the Fear began to gradually become clear.

「This public forum is made up of a huge 'discarded story'.」

The stories that were not properly covered in the main story, those stories came together to form one huge world, and that is this 'public forum'.

Then, it felt like a cluster of letters waiting for the surrounding pale darkness to be called out.

「Disaster-level Fear refers to a 'Fear' that causes regular or irregular deaths of at least 50 to 10,000 people.」

「The cause of Disaster-level Fear is mainly a mutated 'Legendary Story'.」

Disaster-level Fear is a legendary story.

So that means that 'Shark-Head', or 'Tooth Fin', is a Fear based on a legendary story.

When I looked back, the Tooth Fin stopped and shook its large tail, looking at me.

I don't know why, but right after eating the story I gave it, it had been following me at a certain distance. Fortunately, it didn't seem to have any hostile intentions.

I continued reading the book. I read it.

「A Natural Disaster-level Fear refers to a level of 'Fear' that causes a whole world to go crazy.」

「The cause of a Natural Disaster-level Fear is mainly a mutated 'Quasi Mythical-Grade Story.'」

According to the records, the 'Tooth Fin' that tried to destroy Murim was also temporarily recorded as a 'Natural Disaster-level.'

If the destruction of Murim is a 'Natural Disaster-level,' then what about the next level, 'End-level,' will it be? Will Jaehwan-ssi, an outsider, appear?

Unfortunately, most of the descriptions about 'End-level Fear' were covered with ■.

It seems that the recorders of this contest controlled the description, and it seems that they couldn't control all the descriptions in the picture, so there was one piece of advice that I was grateful for.

「The End-level Fear is loyal to the 'End Area,' and no matter what happens, it will never enter the 'Beginning Area.'」

"If Han Sooyoung wrote this much..."

—She means you absolutely must not go.

"Since it's so clear, I feel like I'll definitely go, so I'm worried."

—That's always the case with Ways of Survival.

"Can't you at least tell me that I don't have to go?"

Kim Dokja giggled.

—But you still have to go to the Middle Area. That's how you can find the Second.

The Middle Area.

Even in the beginning area, there's a monster like 'Tooth Fin', so if I go to the Middle Area, there'll definitely be something worse.

"Can't I just call him again?"

—No.

"Why? Did you fight with the Second?"

—That's...

It must be because of the reason he mentioned before.

The Demon King of Salvation said so. The other Kim Dokjas didn't agree with the 'First Kim Dokja's' intentions. If that's the case, there must have been some kind of misunderstanding and conflict. It's important to resolve that.

"This is what I think. Kim Dokja and Kim Dokja need to talk."

—That's a good point.

"So let's talk."

—He has to answer the phone to talk. I told you that you can't make a phone call here.

"It worked just now, right?"

—That's okay because he called, but if we want to call, we have to go somewhere else.

"Where else?"

—You already know that place.

I thought for a moment and then asked.

"Is it the Time Fault in the dark dimension?"

—That's right.

Is that the place?

The place where the Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk, the fallen swordsman Namgung Minyoung, and the Paradoxical Baekcheong Kyrgios were reborn as 'Transcendents'.

The cradle and grave of the martial artists who dream of the stars in the sky.

—The entrance to that place is from the 'Middle Area'.

In the end, I have to get to the Middle Area anyway.

I thought it was far away. I had passed countless Traffic Lights and all sorts of Catastrophic Fearrs on my way here. I had almost died several times. How many more times would I have to go through something similar in the future? Should I experience it?

[An 'Unknown Fear' has found you!]

That was when a bright light shone from afar.

A long object approached with a dull roar and a rattling sound.

Wait, that thing…

—Hmm. That’s it.

A subway was running in the darkness without even a railroad.

If you think about it, there is a world where Fear related to 'Traffic Lights' exists, so it’s not strange that there is Fear related to the 'Subway'.

That’s certainly understandable.

The problem was the announcement that came with the approaching subway.

【We will do our best to make the subway a comfortable and convenient place that puts the safety of our customers first.】

The moment I heard the announcement, my bones throbbed and my stomach rumbled.

【Passengers heading to…, please take this train.】

The appearance of the train seemed somehow familiar. The moment we saw the train name brightly shining on the front, Kim Dokja and I muttered at the same time.

“Really. It's driving me crazy."

—I agree.

That train was the very same train that Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk rode in the 'First Scenario.'

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 819 Episode 41 Sophistry (3)

—Youngest.

"I will never do that."

I said, looking at the approaching subway lights.

"It's obvious what's going to happen inside, so why would I do that?"

Again, that subway was definitely the train from the 'First Scenario'. The train where all the people inside the train were annihilated, the very train where the 「Proof of Value Scenario」 started.

—It could just be a train. If you take that, you'll be able to get there faster.

"It's Bulkwang Station 3434? Have you forgotten that important train number?"

—What kind of person remembers something like that? And aren't you being too nervous?

What happened there was only the 'First Scenario'.

Kim Dokja's words made sense.

What happened there was only the 'First Scenario'. This is a story from when my body average was 1. And now, I have surpassed 100 in comprehensive ability a long time ago, and I am strong enough to fight even the most great constellations.

"You seem to have forgotten, but this is the 'Fear Realm'. Do you think that is simply the stage for the First Scenario?"

I haven't checked the Fear level of that subway yet, but some 'Fears' in this world have strong enough control to control the power of the constellations. The Traffic Lights that were Disaster-level Fears were that strong, so what if that subway is even worse?

What if the First Scenario is about to break out inside there, and the suppression power of that scenario is strong enough to crush even me?

—Hmm, Youngest.

"I won't ride it."

—No, listen to me.

"I won't ride it."

—That's why I said not to say that...

"I said not to ride it."

—Don't say that! That's the trigger!

"Huh?"

[An 'Unknown Fear' has been unlocked.]

[Catastrophic Fear 'Strong Negation is Strong Affirmation' is activated!]

What?

['Strong Negation is Strong Affirmation's effect is realized!]

The moment I blinked, I was already on the subway.

---

rlaehrwk41: Is Yoo Joonghyuk on board too?

rlaehrwk37: Be quiet

…

【Who just said that?】

---

If I think about it, 「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」 is a story that has a deep connection with subway. The First Scenario starts in the subway, and the final scenario ends in the subway.

But now that I'm on that subway, the subway background is starting to feel metaphorical.

Maybe all Kim Dokjas are destined to never be able to escape this damn subway line.

Thump.

I looked around while holding onto the subway handle. The inside of the subway was an ordinary scene from the commute home that you can see anywhere. People sitting in the seats, people standing. Everyone was looking down and concentrating on their smartphones as if they had made a promise.

Are those people real or fake?

I don’t know. After entering the state of Fear, I can’t really tell what is fantasy and what is reality.

I glanced at those people, then quietly turned my gaze and checked the subway car number.

3807.

As expected, it was 'that car' that Kim Dokja had ridden. Damn it.

—Youngest.

The phone call that had been disconnected for a moment was reconnected.

I asked urgently.

"What the hell was that? Why was I suddenly on the subway—"

The moment I answered, the passengers' eyes were all focused on me. My hair stood on end, and there was a ringing in my ears. Along with a slight dizziness…

「Stand ing on the sub way」

A strong feeling of nausea…

「Tal king on the phone」

It felt like the world was turning upside down…

「That's rude.」

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' activates!]

I hung up the phone in a hurry, and the gazes that had been looking at me returned to where it was. The dizziness disappeared and my vision returned to its original position.

I took a few deep breaths to calm my startled heart, then selected 'me' from my smartphone contacts and sent a text message.

'Let's talk like this.'

Thankfully, I got a reply.

—Let's do that.

'Please explain the situation briefly. I don't understand what's going on.'

—The story that brought you into the subway is a Disaster-level Fear that roams the Fear Realm. The Fear name is 'Strong Negation is Strong Affirmation.'

'This subway is a different Fear, right?'

—That's right.

'Why did that Fear show up now?'

—You were just unlucky. Well, there's something a little uneasy, but I'll talk about that later.

'No, don't talk about it later.'

—Youngest, since it’s come to this, let’s think positively. What’s a subway? It’s just a means of transportation.

'In this story, the subway is a direct route to the underworld.'

—Don’t think so negatively. Maybe we can get to the place we want faster.

'Please search for related information quickly. Isn’t this subway in the book written by Han Sooyoung?'

Actually, I could search for it and read it, but I couldn’t do it right now. It’s because my stomach was still upset from the aftereffects of the stares I received before.

Fortunately, Kim Dokja seemed to have guessed my condition.

—Wait a minute.

After talking up to that point, I raised my head and saw pitch-black darkness flowing outside the subway window. As I stared at that darkness, the events that would happen in the future came to mind one after another.

「The First Scenario began in this subway car.」

Then a question suddenly occurred to me. If all Fears are 'discarded stories', why does this subway exist in this 'Fear Realm'?

Because it has lost its use in the scenario?

Or maybe it's the opposite.

For example, if this train existed here before the 'First Scenario'.

My short doubt disappeared along with the vibration of my smartphone.

—Youngest, sit down for now.

It was clear that Kim Dokja was telling me to sit down and calm down.

I was currently standing, holding onto the handrail.

And in front of me were 'two empty seats' waiting for me.

I looked down at those seats and replied.

'No.'

—Why?

'It's suspicious at first glance, so why would I sit there?'

Again, this was the subway on the way home from work. The way home from work.

How could there be two empty seats like that on the way home from work?

Even among the people standing, no one wanted to sit in those seats.

—Then you should sit down more. Then something will start.

So I hope it doesn’t start— I thought to myself, but my body was moving without me realizing it.

Even though my answer was crooked, I also knew that sitting there was the right decision.

No. More precisely,

This would be more 'fun'.

I thought that this is how people gradually become more interested in something, but the moment I sat down, my body magically became comfortable.

'Wow, this.'

I really couldn't express it in words other than the feeling of sitting in an empty seat on the subway on the way home from work.

—I found the related file. I'll put it up for you, so read it.

I immediately started reading the file that Kim Dokja sent me.

| |
|---|
| * Part of this document was modified by SVRP.<br><br>SVRP. PW ?<br><br>Disaster-level Fear— Subway on the way home |

'Traffic Lights' and 'Tooth Fins'… I thought that the 'PW' that was mentioned in every document was an abbreviation for 'Parallel World'—in other words, 'Parallel Universe'.

The parallel world line of Ways of Survival is based on the return episode of Yoo Joonghyuk, so if it's PW 041, it would mean the 41st Round, and if it's PW 0, it would mean the 0th Round.

This time, it's expressed as '?', so it seems that this Fear doesn't have a set Round.

Anyway, I decided to keep reading.

> A mysterious train on the way home that often appears throughout the Fear Realm. It takes the passengers to the 'desired place' in the Fear Realm.

Kim Dokja's guess was right.

It was a 'real means of transportation', right?

But the explanation continued after that.

There's no way an ordinary means of transportation would have this many detailed explanations.

I already don't want to read it.

> Out of the total 872 recorded statistics, the probability of successfully arriving at the destination using the train was 4.5%.
>
> All passengers who failed to arrive at the destination went missing.

I cursed inwardly.

I quickly turned the page.

Yeah, even if only 4.5% survived, they're still alive.

Fortunately, there was a clear record.

A normal clear record for the 'Fear' was observed in PW 0838.

[Click here!]

When I clicked the LCD, a scene flowed out in real time before my eyes. The inside of a burning subway. The screams of people and bloodstains spread here and there.

It reminded me of the First Scenario. I heard someone muttering on the screen.

「"You idiots."」

I only heard their voices, but I knew who they were.

Unfortunately, that was the end of the visual aid.

I continued reading.

If even one passenger in a certain car is killed, the car is immediately declared a 'Crime Zone'. The crime zone continues until the last passenger is left.

…

The surviving passengers of the 'Crime Zone' are summoned to the front car of the train.

The 'Crime Zone' is declared again in the front car, and continues until the last passenger is left.

The last passenger can communicate with the 'Engineer' to get off at the desired area of the Fear Realm.

PW 0838, the last passenger.

King Yoo Joonghyuk.

I knew it.

Since he's 'Yoo Joonghyuk', he could clear the Fear in this way.

Let's see. Are there any other records?

> PW 0912.
>
> Confirmed deaths of all 48 named passengers, including Payhu and Nirobana.
>
> PW 0912 Final passenger.
>
> Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung.

Like disciple, like master.

> PW 01042 Final passenger.
>
> God of wine and Ecstasy.

Wait a minute, the scale is getting bigger, and there's even a round where the 12 gods of Olympus are participating?

> PW 01284 Final passenger.
>
> Abyssal Black Flame Dragon.

A cold sweat ran down the back of my neck.

I heard a loud noise from somewhere and turned around to see a battle already taking place in the front passenger compartment.

A man was annihilating all the passengers in the passenger compartment. The heads of the passengers who rushed in like evil spirits rolled on the floor like toys.

A wide back that reminded me of Yoo Joonghyuk, his disheveled hair, and his familiar sword. I could clearly feel it even through the entrance. That's a constellation.

A powerful constellation at that.

A constellation I know very well.

—Goryeo Swordsman.

'I think it's right.'

Goryeo Swordsman Cheok Jungyeong is on this train.

No, why on earth.

—That guy is always looking for ways to become stronger. This isn't the first time he's been in the Fear Realm.

Wait.

I thought about asking him for help, but when I thought about it, it was suicide.

Once the 'Crime Zone' starts, there is only one final survivor on the train.

No matter how kind Goryeo Swordsman is, he would cut my head off at the crucial moment.

Following that, a commotion was heard from the other car along with a loud noise.

It seemed that the 'Crime Zone' had already broken out in most cars except our car.

Despite the commotion, the passengers in car 3807 were calm. People who calmly buried their heads in their smartphones as if they couldn't hear the commotion.

My mind was getting a little complicated.

Should I also start a 'Crime Zone' like this?

—Can you win a fight with Goryeo Swordsman?

'I can't win.'

—Then just stay still.

'What if I can't get out?'

—It's better than being killed. And you haven't read much yet. Read the rest.

It was easy to see why Kim Dokja had told me to keep reading.

PW ■■ and, PW ■■■ additional clear records observed.

It was confirmed that the survivors of the corresponding round did not use the 'Crime Zone'.

There is! A record of clearing without using the 'Crime Zone'.

But the records that followed completely betrayed my expectations.

**[This record has been censored in accordance with the spoiler prevention policy.]**

[This record has been censored in accordance with the spoiler prevention policy.]

'Are you kidding me?'

—Still, it's not like there was no harvest at this point.

Kim Dokja is right. At least there is a clear way to escape without causing the 'Crime Zone'. Just confirming that is enough.

'Is there a time limit for this Fear?'

—There is no such record. It says that on average, trains that once had a 'Crime Zone' would clear all the cars within 30 minutes.

30 minutes.

I asked while organizing my thoughts.

'Isn't there a way you can think of?'

—Well? However… there's something I'm a little curious about.

'It's another one.'

—Why did this train recognize 'Crime Zone' as the correct interpretation?

The moment I was about to answer what that meant, a symbol appeared on the LCD screen, indicating that the communication signal was not being received, with a slight spark.

Why now?

To be honest, I was flustered, but since this wasn't the first time I'd experienced this, I decided to stay calm.

I can't just borrow Kim Dokja's wisdom forever.

The Fears of this Fear Realm were unfamiliar to Kim Dokja. Neither he nor I knew the answer.

「Why 'Crime Zone' could be the correct interpretation.」

I thought about the hint Kim Dokja left at the end.

All Fears have an 'interpretation' that is connected to the way they originated. Just like the Traffic Lights and the Tooth Fins.

Then why did this train recognize 'Crime Zone' as an interpretation?

Is there some kind of probability between the train and violence?

No matter how much I think about it, I can't figure it out.

No matter what conditions related to violence I think of, I don't think they go well with this subway.

If the subway on the way home from work recognized 'Crime Zone' as an interpretation, there must be a reason for it.

My head is starting to hurt.

It wouldn't have been Kim Dokja, but it would have been nice if there was someone who could help me a little.

Like Yoo Sangah. Wait a minute.

Yoo Sangah?

The moment I thought about that, one of the doors on the train opened and closed. It happened so quickly that I couldn't even think of running towards it.

A new passenger who had just boarded was standing in front of the door. Their eyes were looking around anxiously.

It was a character I knew.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

# 820 Episode 41 Sophistry (4)

Her eyes widened as she found me sitting in the seat.

"You."

Her blond hair swayed in the wind. Her eyes shook as if she was agitated.

I waved my hand lightly at her and smiled.

"It's been a while."

I never thought we would meet in a place like this.

Her expression hardened at my greeting, and she hesitated for a moment before approaching me briskly.

"Cheon Inho."

The person who called me 'Cheon Inho'.

"Why are you here?"

Prophet Anna Croft.

She was in the same 'Fear' as me.

---

As I live, there will come a day when I ride the same subway as Anna Croft.

I thought about my last encounter with her. The last time I saw her was at the 'Washington Dome'.

At that time, I fell into 'Gingagap', a trap set by <Asgard>, and there, I borrowed the power of the Demon King of Salvation and defeated the great Constellations. Come to think of it, I owed Anna Croft that time. If she hadn’t processed the 'Lesser Dragon's Heart' with her own trait, neither I nor the Demon King of Salvation would have been able to summon the power of 'Cheok Jungyeong' as a [bookmark].

Now that I think about it, Cheok Jungyeong is here too. I don’t know if it was a coincidence or not, but things were going quite strangely.

I pointed to the seat next to me and said to Anna Croft.

"Please sit down."

Anna Croft hesitated for a moment, as if she was uncomfortable sitting next to me, and then sat down with a helpless expression.

"What are you planning here?"

"I’m not planning anything in particular."

"What are you planning—"

The moment we got to that point in the conversation, I felt the gaze I had felt the other time.

「On the sub way」

Oh, again.

「You’re tal king too loud ly」

My stomach started to churn and I felt faint dizziness.

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is activated.]

Fortunately, I had already experienced it once, and the [Fourth Wall] was also activated, so I could endure it.

But it seemed that Anna Croft was not like that.

"W-what is this?"

Anna Croft, whose face had turned pale, was already sweating profusely.

Even she, who had a fairly high level of mental barrier, could end up like that.

"Lower your voice."

As I whispered, the gazes aRound her disappeared as if they had been washed away.

Anna Croft, panting and wiping away her sweat, asked.

"What was that just now?"

"Probably a Fear effect."

The subway we were riding in had not yet experienced the 'Crime Zone'.

Judging from the fact that a similar phenomenon occurred when I called and when I spoke to Anna Croft—this place seemed to be a space dominated by the common 'Spirit-Bound Combat Technique' of public transportation.

It could be something like this. Do not talk loudly or make noise. Do not eat food.

Do not make noise.

Give up your seat to pregnant women or the elderly.

Anna Croft also seemed to have noticed the rules.

"A peculiar rule is in effect."

"It's an ordinary rule. This was normal before the scenarios came."

We sat side by side and admired the everyday scenery that we had forgotten. The soft breathing of people. People looking down and concentrating on the small screen.

It felt real again. This was the ordinary world we knew. People in those days were trapped in their own worlds, and perhaps the scenario pulled them out of there.

'Scenarios' that Kim Dokja had read.

I glanced over and saw that Anna Croft was also lost in a short reflection.

She must have sensed my gaze, but she came to her senses and said in a cold voice.

"I knew you were alive, but you're much better than I thought."

Anna Croft seemed to have already heard the news about me.

"You're glad I'm okay, aren't you?"

"No one can go through something like that and be fine."

"Have you heard any rumors?"

"I heard that you were chased by giant nebulae and torn apart."

Torn apart.

That's not wrong.

I was not the one who was 'torn apart' to begin with.

"Wow, it almost turned out like that."

"You're so tenacious that you survived that kind of defeat."

"Because I'm good at coming back from the dead. But why did you come here?"

"Are you really asking because you don't know?"

A thought occurred to me belatedly.

The last time I saw Anna Croft, she went against her own Nebula, <Asgard>, to help me.

I knew what the incarnation that went against the nebulae would say.

"You seem to be blooming too."

"Thanks to who? I was going to ask you about it at the Recycling Center anyway..."

"Um, I didn't see you there?"

"I didn't know you were a crazy person who wanted to clear it all the way."

"Did you come all the way to the Fear Realm to chase me?"

"Look here. Do I look like someone who's free?"

"Then why did you come to the Fear Realm?"

"I'm not the incarnation of <Asgard> anymore. What choice would an abandoned incarnation have?"

"Aha, you're thinking of becoming a Transcendent."

The only path left for her abandoned by <Asgard>.

Anna Croft had come here to climb the only ladder of social mobility that a mortal abandoned by the Constellations could attempt.

"I think that's also a failure since I came all the way here to meet you."

"Come on, let's forget about the old days and get along. That's how we'll get out of here. We'll go out and become Transcendents, and take revenge on the Constellations . Anyway, let's go on good terms."

Anna Croft muttered as if she was shocked at what I said.

"On good terms? Do you think that's possible between you and me?"

"I've become a colleague with Yoo Joonghyuk. I'll embrace you with a big heart."

"Who's talking to whom right now—"

Anna Croft, who was about to shout, suddenly stopped talking. The passengers' eyes were turned towards her.

Anna Croft asked again, sighing as if she was going to collapse.

"Cheon Inho. Do you know anything about this 'Fear'?"

I nodded and briefly relayed the information I knew.

Anna Croft nodded after hearing my story.

"I expected it since the backgRound was the subway. Then I guess we'll have to create a Crime Zone to get out of here."

"I'm against it."

"Against it?"

"We have to find a way to get out without activating the Crime Zone."

"Didn't you say that the method is unknown? With your abilities, you could easily be the last one standing even if you use the 'Crime Zone'."

"You were on board with me, of all people."

Anna Croft looked momentarily flustered.

"Because of me?"

"The Cheon Inho of this world line is quite affectionate."

"You always said that and aimed for my back."

"Cheok Jungyeong is riding in the next car."

"Cheok… Jungyeong?"

"Do you know the Goryeo Swordsman?"

"Oh, no way—"

Only then did Anna Croft's face turn pale as if she realized the situation.

"We're dead."

"That's why I need your ability now."

Come to think of it, it was my good fortune to meet Anna Croft now. Anna Croft was the incarnation with the ability specialized in this 'Fear Realm'.

"Can you see something in [Future Sight]?"

Anna Croft can read the future with [Future Sight]. This means that if she uses her ability well, she can also power up the threatening Fear that will come in the future.

But Anna Croft's expression was unusual.

"No."

"Why?"

"My [Future Sight] lost its power after coming here."

Anna Croft glared at me for a moment as if she didn't want to admit it, then added,

"It's as if the entire future is covered in fog."

This was unexpected.

She can't see the future. Why?

Looking back, there were several times in the main story when 'Anna Croft's' prophetic ability was blocked.

Why was that?

Oh... Wait a minute. Could it be?

A hypothesis suddenly came to mind.

To verify that hypothesis, I reviewed Han Sooyoung's guide once again. But why?

[Some spoilers in this document have been removed.]

Some sentences that were previously marked as 'spoilers' have been released.

> A common experience was observed in all passengers who survived without using the 'Crime Zone' in the subway.
>
> All passengers who successfully escaped stated that 「the subway lights blinked three times」.

The subway lights blinked three times.

It was an incredibly crucial hint. So, what I have to do is make the subway lights blink three times.

Should I cause a power outage?

"Cheon Inho."

"What?"

"Is that how you see it?"

Anna Croft tilted her head slightly, so I hurriedly hid my phone and answered.

"I just read some web novels."

"Novels? You're reading novels in this situation? Are you crazy?"

Anna Croft glared at me like she was looking at a bug, then made a resigned expression.

"I used to read a lot of novels, too."

At that moment, my vision went black for a moment and then came back. My mind was blank.

What? What just happened?

Anna Croft also looked surprised. She hurriedly looked aRound and muttered quietly.

"Is it a power outage?"

My mind felt brighter at the word power outage.

"Anna Croft. Please continue what you were just saying."

"What are you talking about? A power outage?"

"No, you were talking about novels."

"What's the big deal about that right now—"

"Listen to me."

Anna Croft nodded her head slightly at my serious tone.

"But what else do I have to say…"

"Hmm."

I realized that this person is also quite inexperienced at having conversations.

After all, she is a 'Prophet'.

A being who can read the past and the future. In a sense, she is a character as 'omniscient' as Kim Dokja.

Would a prophet who knows all of someone’s shortcomings and secrets before they even become close to her really make an effort to build deep relationships with others?

Perhaps all humans would look like characters with past and future plots in front of her.

Thinking about it that way, I could finally understand Anna Croft’s attitude toward her colleagues.

Fortunately, I am a more social person than Kim Dokja or Anna Croft.

"Do you have a favorite author?"

"Ah."

Anna Croft nodded belatedly and answered.

"There is."

"Who is it?"

"Ted Chang, Charles Yu, Liu Cixin. And…"

I smiled, feeling like I expected it.

Well, Anna wouldn't read web novels.

Anna Croft let out a snarl, interpreting my smile.

"Are you making fun of my reading tastes?"

"No, I just laughed because I thought it suited you well."

"Who do you like?"

"My favorite author."

I muttered, looking at the letters shining on the screen of my smartphone.

"It's someone named Han Sooyoung."

Anna Croft muttered, "Han Sooyoung," and tilted her head.

"I've never heard of that author before. Is she a famous author in Korea?"

"In some worldline."

Anna Croft tilted her head for a moment, as if imagining a worldline where Han Sooyoung is famous.

In the meantime, I was staring at the ceiling light. The light was flickering, emitting an uncertain light that seemed to be fading.

It was almost like a blink, which was a pity.

Is this not enough?

In that case, I had no choice but to resort to a desperate measure.

"Anna Croft, what role will I assign you from now on?"

"Yes?"

"You are Korean from now on and your name is Kim Anna."

"What?"

"Ms. Kim Anna. Do you speak Spanish?"

Kim Anna looked at me with her typical bewildered expression, then answered as if she had no choice but to follow along.

"I know a little bit."

"Puede prestarme dinero."

Kim Anna asked back with a dumbfounded expression.

"Why are you suddenly asking me to lend you money?"

"Do you have any apps you can recommend for me?"

"Apps?"

"Like apps to learn Spanish."

"Cheon Inho. What the hell are you talking about?"

"Inho has an Inho's life."

"What?"

"And Anna has an Anna's life."

At that moment, the lights flickered again.

I felt a surge of joy inside.

As expected, my guess was right.

Anna Croft asked back in a bewildered voice.

"What did you do just now?"

"Be quiet."

It was clear now.

I muttered as I looked back at the passengers. I don’t know if it was one of them or someone outside this space.

"We’re being 'audited' right now."

Someone was watching us here.

"What—"

"Do you remember what the First Scenario was?"

The First Scenario was about 'killing a living being'.

The name of the scenario was 'Proof of Worth'.

Proof of Worth.

Every incarnation had to prove their 'worth' to 'someone' through the First Scenario.

Anna, who had been looking aRound, asked with a hardened expression.

"No way. The Constellations are watching?"

"Not Constellations."

"Then?"

"I don’t know. I think we have to make them happy to get out."

The lights had blinked twice so far. And both of those blinks happened when I parodied the development of the 'main story'.

But now there was no more main story content to parody. The situation where even the 'Reader's Life', which was a desperate measure, was used. In terms of the main story development, this was the 'beginning of the scenario'.

It means that the 'Crime Zone' must open.

"Then the 'Crime Zone' is..."

"It would have been the easiest way to entertain someone."

In fact, I had a vague idea of who that 'someone' was.

「At least this Fear is related to Kim Dokja.」

In the first place, the only people who would enjoy watching the parody of the main story would be Kim Dokja or Kim Dokja's acquaintances.

Then, the way to make the subway lights blink is simple.

All I had to do was start a story that would make even that 'Kim Dokja' curious.

"Anna Croft."

Fortunately, I was with someone who knew one of those stories.

"I want to know exactly what happened in the last 40th Round."

This was also something I was curious about.

Anna Croft asked, lightly puffing out one cheek and then bursting it.

"Cheon Inho. What are you up to? I'd rather ask you about the last Round."

"I don't know much because I lost my memories of that Round. What happened? What did I do? Why do you and Yoo Joonghyuk hate me so much."

A story I should have found out a long time ago, but kept putting off.

"I don't know anything. That's why I want to know."

Taking a deep breath, an old memory suddenly came to mind.

The red coat. The wings of the Demon King, the being called 'the Evil Sophist' by the Constellations.

The two blades that crossed to kill each other.

Perhaps it was a question I should have asked a long time ago. In order to meet the Second Kim Dokja, to become a proper comrade with Yoo Joonghyuk, in order to resolve this 'Fear', I—

"Who on earth is 'Cheon Inho' from the 40th Round?"

I need to know exactly who I am first.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 821 Episode 41 Sophistry (5)

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In a way, it was a ridiculous idea.

「Attracting Kim Dokja's attention with an interesting 'Story'.」

It's not like Scheherazade, and there's no way that Fear can be solved just by telling a plausible story.

[NOTE 1]

Nevertheless, I was convinced that this was possible.

More than anything, there were several 'metaphors' in this subway.

「The subway's blinking lights.」

Han Sooyoung's guide explained.

Only those who saw the lights blink three times in total survived.

How about saying it like this? 「Blinking」 is not just a 'light'.

「Eye.」

What if that 'light' is an 'eye' watching us?

It wasn't just that.

I looked at the passengers lined up here and there. Strangely, none of them were wearing earphones.

「Ear.」

They are listening to our story.

If you think about it that way, a pretty plausible story is completed.

The space where you accidentally hear other people's stories is 'public transportation.'

Kim Dokja also used public transportation. He must have read and reread 'Ways of Survival' while riding the 'subway home from work' countless times.

In that sense, this subway was the space where Kim Dokja was more absorbed in the story than anyone else.

Now the premise is complete. The question is whether the gambler in Las Vegas will help me.

"Didn't you just forget about the old days?"

"I'll go and do well. I can forget."

"You are really—"

Anna Croft glared at me, then grabbed my hand and held it. I could barely understand her agony, which was contained in the short movement.

She was now putting the weight of her memories on the scale.

She wondered whether it would be good to tell Cheon Inho, who was in front of her, about what happened last time.

I decided to strike first.

"Just a few things to keep in mind, I am not Cheon Inho from the 40th Round."

Anna Croft, who was surprised by my words, raised her head and looked at me.

"Whatever Cheon Inho you remember was, I am different from him."

"That's."

"Just like Yoo Joonghyuk from the First Round was different from Yoo Joonghyuk from the Second Round."

"…"

"Just like Anna Croft was different in the Third and Fourth Rounds."

"The essence of a human being doesn't change easily."

"What do you think constitutes the essence of a human being?"

Anna Croft hesitated for a moment.

"The essence of a human being."

"It's the total sum of the history they have chosen and decided to live by."

Anna looked at me as if she was a little surprised, then slowly nodded.

"That's right. Everything in this world is made of 'stories'."

Her eyes were watching me. As long as I had the [Fourth Wall], those eyes wouldn't be able to read anything from me.

So what she was reading now was not me, but the stories of this world that she and I shared.

The things we did together in Washington. And even the rumors about the Recycling Center.

"I really can't figure out what you're thinking. You're suddenly talking about a novel, and you're making me play a strange role. And then."

Anna added, still clenching and unclenching her fist repeatedly.

"Now you're asking me to tell you who you are."

"Because only you can tell me that."

Now, almost no one remembers the 40th Round. Even Yoo Joonghyuk forgot most of his memories from the 40th Round in exchange for the 'Story Imprint'. The only one who properly remembered what happened in that Round was Anna Croft, a Prophet who could use [Past Sight].

Finally, Anna clenched her fist, as if she had decided on something.

"You."

The flesh on her palm, pressed against her fingernails, turned red.

"You were a piece of human trash."

"I already know that."

There is no reader who doesn't know that Cheon Inho is trash.

But Anna Croft's words didn't end there.

"If it weren't for you, so many people would have survived. Las Vegas wouldn’t have been destroyed, and the Korean Peninsula would have been intact.”

I expected it, but the scale was bigger than I thought.

Cheon Inho ruined Las Vegas and the Korean Peninsula?

"The great evils gathered under your banner, and the Demon War broke out. You and they messed up the scenarios."

"…"

"If you hadn’t fooled the Constellations, if you hadn’t made up some plausible excuses… Maybe Yoo Joonghyuk wouldn’t have had to regress."

I smiled bitterly.

Because that couldn’t have happened.

It was only the 40th Round. There was no way that Yoo Joonghyuk, the Regressor, could see the 'End' in that 40th Round.

However, the moment I heard Anna Croft’s voice, I couldn’t laugh anymore.

"Because you were one of Yoo Joonghyuk’s closest colleagues."

"Colleague?"

I wondered what that meant.

Because.

"Why didn’t he make me his colleague a long time ago?"

"He should have. But this life is too late."

Because in the memories I saw before, Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk were never colleagues.

「"Don't even think about making me your colleague. I will be your enemy in the next Round. I will be your enemy again and again."」

They were mortal enemies, and they couldn't tolerate each other.

My head was in confusion.

What on earth does that mean?

They were colleagues before they fought?

No, is that even a possible setting in the first place?

"Please tell me exactly. Me and Yoo Joonghyuk were colleagues in the 40th Round?"

"That..."

Anna Croft's expression suddenly changed as she spoke.

"Oh, oh. Oh...?"

I felt an ominous feeling, and her whole body was shaking. Her red eyes turned white, and sparks jumped from her body that was turned white. And.

The lights were blinking.

Once. Twice. Three times.

FourFiveSixSevenEightNineTenElevenTwelveThirteenFourteenFifteenSixteenSeventeenEighteenNineteenTwentyTwentyOneTwentyTwentyTwentyThreeTwentyFourteenTwentySixteenTwentySeventeenEighteenNineteenTwentyTwentyOneTwentyTwoTwentyThreeTw

entyFourTwentyFiveTwentySixTwentySevenTwentyEightTwentyNineThirtyThirtyOneThirtyTwoThirtyThreeThirtyFourThirtyFiveThirtySixThirtySevenThirtyEightThirtyNineForty

[Exclusive skill the 'Fourth Wall' is strongly activated!]

Something is wrong.

"Anna Croft! Come to your senses!"

I grabbed Anna urgently and shook her, but her consciousness had long since disappeared.

At that moment, the smartphone screen flashed. The guide's new information had been unlocked.

> All passengers who escaped from the subway without using the 'Crime Zone' were moved to ■■■■.
>
> ■■■ is what the passenger said ■■■?
>
> * Part of this document has been censored by SVRP.
>
> All subways head to the 'Destination'.

All subways head to the destination.

Destination? Where on earth is that?

Is it a good thing? It seemed that the subway's goal was gradually being found.

Passengers fell unnaturally.

Beyond the pitch-black window, I saw a huge streamlined body running beside the subway.

【TeethTeethTeethTeethTeethTeethTeethTeeth!】

It was a fin.

Did it really follow me all this time?

【TeethTeethTeethTeethTeethTeethTeethTeethTeeth!】

The eyes of the guy moving urgently. It seemed to be warning me.

Escape from here immediately.

The guy's huge body crashed into the subway several times, and its fierce fangs collided with the side of the subway.

For a moment, I felt anticipation.

Tooth Fin is a 'Disaster-level Fear'. In some Rounds, it was even recorded as a 'Natural Disaster-level Fear'.

If it were him, wouldn't he be able to get me and Anna Croft out of this subway?

【……!】

A loud noise that tore through my eardrums, intense sparks shot out all over the 'Tooth Fin's' body. 'Tooth Fin's' body bounced away helplessly.

After all, this subway seemed like it couldn't be handled by Outer Gods even by force.

[Notice to passengers on board.]

I felt a little strange. I instinctively grabbed Anna Croft's arm, but I couldn't feel it in my hand. I felt my senses gradually becoming paralyzed along with the feeling of time and space gradually becoming distorted.

My vision blinked very slowly.

As if an electric motor blinked.

Once, twice.

【You will soon arrive at your destination.】

Three times.

【'Subway Homecoming' cheers for your safe return home.】

My vision disappeared.

【Hmm, that's right.】

【He piqued the curiosity of the Master of Fear too much.】

【Well, the way home from work is originally rough.】

---

My vision returned.

The moment I swallowed my breath, I was galloping through the meadow.

I almost fell over, but I managed to keep my balance and kept running.

It wasn't as good as [Way of the Wind], but it was definitely an amazing lightness technique.

What could it be? I have never learned this kind of martial arts.

"Chase that guy!"

I hurriedly turned around at the sound of the voice, and the masked men were running alongside me.

It didn't take long for me to figure out the situation.

My side profile was briefly reflected in the masked man's dagger running nearby.

Black mask.

I was also wearing a mask. In short, I wasn't being chased by them, but was 'chasing someone' with them.

I briefly checked my body while running. My physical condition didn't seem to have changed much, and my eyes were normal.

Then.

I put my hand in my bosom to figure out the situation. It was to find my smartphone.

Perhaps this situation was also a production based on 'Fear'. All Fear is a 'discarded tale', and most Fears have a re-experiential nature, so I might have entered the records of a fragment of a tale that existed in the past.

If so, there might be a hint in Han Sooyoung's guide or 'Ways of Survival'. Even if there are no hints there, I have the First Kim Dokja. If only the call could be connected safely —

Hmm?

None. My heart sank lightly.

I put my hands in my bosom several times. I searched my pants pockets and my back pocket.

My smartphone was gone.

And that wasn't all. Most of the items I had were gone. I had no Unbreakable Faith or Thoughts. Of course, my coat was gone.

[Information synchronization complete.]

I felt my head opening up along with a slight headache.

「Way of the Wind carried by my toes.」

Fortunately, the skills I had seemed to have been synchronized.

Yes, if I had the ability, I wouldn't be flustered.

There is nothing.

Even without a smartphone, I can figure out where this place is on my own.

"It's over there! It's that guy!"

It didn't take long for me to figure out the situation.

The man the masked men were chasing appeared in front of me.

I slowly opened my eyes and looked at the target.

The fluttering black coat and the strangely familiar wide back.

Thinking that something was strange, I widened my eyes even more, or at that moment, with a "spot~" sound, the masked man's head flew off.

"Kwaaaaak!"

What the hell.

I quickly got out of the group and hid in a nearby forest.

I wondered if those crazy guys were attacking Yoo Joonghyuk, but the masked men's skills were no joke. Judging from the martial arts they were using, I thought they were probably the best of the previous generation, or maybe the elite of the Demonic Cult or Blood Cult.

Of course, Yoo Joonghyuk is Yoo Joonghyuk, no matter who the opponent is.

The guy swung his [Breaking the Sky Sword] mercilessly and killed the masked men. One, twenty, thirty. In an instant, the nearby forest was filled with blood.

But Yoo Joonghyuk, who was carrying out such a merciless massacre, did not look in good condition at all.

I immediately noticed his condition.

He was poisoned.

The pale complexion of the farmer proved it. Perhaps the intangible poison—or a poison comparable to the heavenly poison—was eating away at his entire body.

He must have fallen into a trap, or walked into one himself.

In an instant, over a hundred incarnations fell to the ground, and Yoo Joonghyuk started running again.

Cut, run, fall, cut, run.

Cut.

How much time had passed?

Finally, Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been staggering, knelt down. I was the only masked person left around him.

I came out of the water and cautiously approached him. You could tell just by looking at him. Yoo Joonghyuk had no magic left. He seemed to have already used [Knight Resurrection].

"Yoo…!"

I was about to speak to Yoo Joonghyuk, but I stopped because I felt something strange.

The guy was glaring at me.

"The energy is strange."

If Yoo Joonghyuk had seen me, he would have asked for help from me.

But he didn't.

「Yoo Joonghyuk didn't recognize me.」

I reflexively used [Character List]. And.

[Exclusive skill 'Character List' activates!]

[There is too much information about the character in question. 'Character List' will be converted to 'Summary List'.]

**<Character Summary>**

Name: Yoo Joonghyuk

Exclusive trait: Regressor 40 times> (Myth), Pro-gamer (Legendary)…

Exclusive skills: [Sage's Eye Lv. 10], [Hand to Hand Combat Lv. 10], [Weapon Training Lv. 10], [Mental Barrier Lv. 10]…

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was glaring at me as if he was going to kill me, collapsed forward.

Then, I heard the loud voices of the masked men from beyond the bushes.

"Over there!"

I looked down at the back of Yoo Joonghyuk's head, who had fallen.

While thinking that such a thing could not be possible, I could not deny the great battle unfolding before my eyes.

I told the supervisor the story of the '40th Round' on the subway.

And if my skill was not wrong, the guy who had fallen with the back of his head exposed was Yoo Joonghyuk of the '40th Round' that I had only heard of.

「All subways head towards the 'Destination'.」

My head rang.

"There it is!"

Damn it. I don't know.

Right now, I had to think about something certain.

Right now, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 40th Round was lying in front of me, and I had two choices.

Should I save Yoo Joonghyuk in front of me, or let him die?

"Kill him!"

I didn't think long.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Scheherazade: A legendary storyteller from Arabian Nights who saved her life by telling stories every night.

# 822 Episode 41 Sophistry (6)

I ran like crazy while carrying Yoo Joonghyuk. My panting breaths reached the tip of my chin, and my heels kicked the dirt floor.

「There was no need to do this.」

I know. My actions right now are useless. This scene is just a virtual '40th Round' staged by 'Fear'. Whether I save Yoo Joonghyuk here or not, the story that has already been decided will be recorded.

But I couldn't shake off the eerie imagination.

「Will it really be recorded?」

What if this 'Fear' is real?

What if Yoo Joonghyuk dies because I don't save him now?

What if history changes like the 1,863rd Round that Kim Dokja visited?

"There he is! That bastard!"

At least Yoo Joonghyuk of the 40th Round wasn't destined to die here. And now, I was the only one who could save him.

"Wake up! Hey!"

I shouted at Yoo Joonghyuk several times, but he didn't respond.

After running away for several hours, I felt my stamina and magic power slowly draining away.

Damn it, Cheon Inho, didn't he even properly raise his overall ability? How on earth did someone like this get nicknames like 'Evil Sophist' or 'The One Who Deceived the Stars'?

"That's it."

A storm of incredible magical power swept in from in front of me along with the familiar voice.

It was clear who he was.

Blood Demon.

A legendary martial arts master who had once joined forces with the Heavenly Demon and even faced the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' was right in front of me.

It was definitely a Transcendent.

It was an incarnation with strength that rivaled even the Highest-Ranking Constellations.

I wondered why such a big shot had suddenly appeared.

"Cheon Inho, why did you suddenly betray us?"

It seems that the big shot knows Cheon Inho.

I opened my mouth with a hurried smile.

"I didn't betray you in particular."

"Put down the tyrant."

"That would be a bit difficult. This guy has a place where I can use him."

"You must be thinking of uncovering the true nature of the Regression Law."

Regression Law.

The Blood Demon seemed to know that Yoo Joonghyuk was a Regressor.

"We must have decided to conduct research on the Law together, didn't we?"

What on earth was Cheon Inho doing in the 40th Round?

I could guess the situation.

That greedy Blood Demon must have been curious about why Yoo Joonghyuk was so strong. After investigating, he found out that Yoo Joonghyuk was a Regressor, and he set a trap with Cheon Inho to steal his power.

Then, my line was set.

"I will uncover the Regression Law and tell you. So, Blood Demon, please step aside for a moment."

"How can I trust you?"

"The Supreme King is already in a state of extreme insanity. If we leave it like this, he will regress before we even find out about the Regression Law."

"..."

"As you know, I have [Incite]. After recovering Yoo Joonghyuk a little, if I [Incite] Yoo Joonghyuk while his mental barrier is weakened, we may be able to find out the secret of regression—"

"I will count to three."

The Blood Demon's voice was cold.

"Leave the tyrant behind and get out. Then I'll spare your life."

I guess this kind of persuasion won't work.

I compared the intensity I felt from the Blood Demon's body with the strength I had. No matter how much I thought about it, I couldn't deal with the Blood Demon with such a weak body.

The only way to deal with the Blood Demon was to wake up Yoo Joonghyuk, but the probability of him waking up after using [Knight Resurrection] was close to zero.

No, why did this kid come to an area where blood cultists were swarming in the first place and make things complicated...

「Why did Yoo Joonghyuk come all the way here?」

Sparks flew in my head.

I carefully moved my hand behind my back and checked one of the wooden armors in the guy's arms.

The moment I read the Chinese characters engraved on the armor, I could immediately understand why Yoo Joonghyuk had come all the way here.

「Blood Spirit Clan.」

A potion similar to the 'Gongcheongseokyu' or 'Doll Theory' of <The 0th Murim>.

Just by taking one pill, you can gain magical powers of over a hundred years. It was a legendary divine water.

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk came here to get this item.

Why?

I don’t know. He might have wanted to take it himself, or he might have wanted to give it to someone.

I took out the blood spirit tablet from the wooden box and the Blood Demon smiled.

"Do you think the situation will change if you eat that?"

I said, pretending to be indifferent.

"At least I can get the Blood Cult’s divine water. If I eat this, you won’t be able to absorb the magic of the Blood Spirits."

The Blood Spirits are a sacred item passed down through generations for the cult’s leaders. It was a terrible item made by sacrificing more than ten thousand masters in order for mortal humans to reach the stars.

I think the Blood Demon who killed the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint also absorbed this 'Blood Spirit Clan'.

So if I threaten him with this item, even if it’s the Blood Demon…

"Try it."

I sensed the dark magic rippling in the Blood Demon’s grasp.

Absorption Technique.

An extremely evil magic technique that absorbs the magic directly from the opponent’s body to increase his own internal energy.

Only then did I realize the Blood Demon’s plan.

The moment I secured the magic with the Blood Spirits, the Blood Demon planned to use [Absorption Technique] to take away the magic.

"Eat it right now."

I cursed inside, but there was no other way. Anyway, I’ll die anyway. If so.

"Then I will eat well."

Without hesitation, I poured the Blood Spirit Clan inside the wooden armor into my mouth.

The Blood Demon's eyes flashed red and burst into rage.

"You idiot. If you eat that as is... !"

I know. Blood Spirit Clan has side effects. The moment you take this medicine, ten thousand vengeful spirits in the pill will attack the user's mind at the same time.

—Hahahahahahahaha!

—You finally took it!

—I'll kill you, I'll kill you, I'll kill you!

—Cult leader! You're finally getting revenge on a hundred years of grudge!

—Huh...?

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is activated!]

The voices of the vengeful spirits that had been heard disappeared in an instant.

While the astonished Blood Demon glared, I felt the intense magical energy pulsating throughout my body.

[Item 'Blood Spirit Clan' matches your characteristics.]

[You are a 'villain' who can fully acquire the functions of 'Blood Spirit Clan'.]

I wondered if this was only making Cheon Inho stronger, but there was no way for me to survive right now.

The Blood Demon, who barely managed to calm his confusion, said.

"How."

"Blood Demon. Have you forgotten who I am?"

"You—"

"I am the 'Evil Sophist' and the 'Star-Deceiver'."

I don't know if Cheon Inho is still called that, but I talked as I pleased and lured the Blood Demon into letting down his guard.

The great Blood Demon tried the absorption method first.

"Die!"

I barely avoided his attack and unleashed my only special skill.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' is activated!]

[The effect of the item 'Blood Spirit Clan' increases the power of incite!]

It felt completely different from the [Incite] I had done before.

Is it because the body I possessed was 'Cheon Inho of the 40th Round'?

The possible and impossible [Incite] orders were neatly organized in my head.

「The 'order' to die is impossible.」

「Use the words that can be used on opponents of similar rank first.」

「The key is Instigation Overlap.」

「Starting from the first stage of instigation, gradually increase the level.」

It was as if someone was telling me how to use [Incite].

I calmly took a breath and spoke to the Blood Demon.

"Are you nervous? Are you afraid that I'm stronger than you?"

"Shut up! You—"

"Let me tell you something important. Even if you obtain the Great Law of Regression, you will never become as strong as the Supreme King."

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 10' is activating!]

The Blood Demon, with his eyes wide open, shouted at me.

"What do you know—"

"From a lowly third-rate villain. On your first trip to the martial arts world, you accidentally collected the remains of a previous great demon and acquired the 'Blood Spirit Divine Skill'."

It was the Blood Demon's secret that also appears in 'Ways of Survival'.

The Blood Demon glared.

"Yes, how did you—"

"You probably know that too. Your talent is not even capable of properly mastering one 'Blood Spirit Divine Art'."

"..."

"You trained for a hundred years and still can't master that one martial art, and you couldn't even endure the 'Time Fault' and jumped out, so how dare you pursue other martial arts?"

"That's—"

"With that much willpower, you dream of 'Regression'?"

['Incite' is strengthened.]

The Blood Demon staggered and shouted.

"I can do it too. If I can return, if I can regress like that guy—"

"No. You can't. Regression is useless to you, who can't even endure a mere hundred years."

"That's not true. I— Me too—!"

The Blood Demon's eyes were suddenly clouded. The demon inside him had manifested doubts about his talent.

Concerns about his will.

All the history that had made him a Transcendent was now his enemy, attacking his mind.

['Incite' is strengthened.]

"Just as a roach can only become a ' roach that has lived for a hundred years' even if it endures for a hundred years, it cannot become a dragon, no matter how much you struggle, you are a third-rate unmanned rascal. Even if you gain good martial arts or return, it is the same. That is your birth. That is how you have lived until now with such a weak mind."

['Incite' is strengthened!]

"There is no need to struggle. The sky is high, and the stars are far away. There is no place for you in the <Star Stream>. You are nothing more than a speck of dust that cannot even play a supporting role. Accept that fact. Then you will be at ease."

"Ah, uh, uh—"

"Go back to where you lived. And don't stick your head out again."

['Incite' succeeded!]

After a while, the Blood Demon, unable to endure the pain, lay on the gRound, flailing its mouth as if it were a loach.

Even though I was watching the process of [Incite] developing in real time right before my eyes, it didn't feel real.

[Incite that takes hold of the opponent's weakness and breaks their spirit.]

Cheon Inho has used this devilish tongue to subdue countless opponents.

I looked down at the Blood Demon for a moment and then started running again.

「Incite doesn't last long. I had to get as far away from here as possible before Incite was released.」

"Oh my God! How much are you!"

The Blood Cult group that had already chased me.

"Chase them! There!"

I ran and ran, but now there was no more escape. The cliff was blocking my way.

I stood at the edge of the cliff and looked down.

What I could see from the edge of the cliff was the rough yet still flowing river.

I had no choice now.

"Hold on tight, Yoo Joonghyuk."

I grabbed the guy by the collar and jumped down the cliff.

This is not Dongho Bridge, and there is no ichthyosaurus to swallow us.

Nevertheless.

I had a feeling that we would not die.

That was, so to speak, a writer's intuition.

Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk would not die here.

And if the two of them survived here.

[You intervened in 'SVRP'.]

The two could become comrades.

[Some of the documents of SVRP 040 will be modified.]

[The Master of Fear approves your records.]

…

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who previously wrote the Fear approves your edits.]

[Your Fear is recorded in the blank space on the wall.]

A voice I knew very well whispered in my ear.

【Good. This is the story I was waiting for. Kim Dokja.】

---

Yoo Joonghyuk was looking up at the night sky of Murim. It was a night sky filled with Constellations he hated.

How long had he been looking at the Constellations like that? Yoo Joonghyuk unconsciously began to count the stars hanging in the sky.

It was strange. He had no habit of counting stars, so why was he counting them?

「"Hold on tight, Yoo Joonghyuk."」

A memory suddenly flashed through his mind. A subtle warmth that did not fit with his life. A sudden bond that should not exist for him.

"Disciple."

Yoo Joonghyuk woke up from his thoughts at the voice from behind him.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was looking down at him as if worried.

A bright light was emitting.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint finally recognized her disciple who had reached the 41st Round.

"Which Round has this been when you have given me memories?"

"It's the 32nd Round."

"I think this is the 41st Round."

"There are also Rounds where you have not given me memories."

Breaking the Sky Swordsman did not ask why he had not given her memories. She simply smiled lightly.

"If you gave me your memories, it means you have a desperate reason."

Yoo Joonghyuk's regression draws in and devours everyone aRound him. It destroys them. It dismantles lives and wears out existence.

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk once again dragged Breaking the Sky Swordsman into the vortex of regression.

"I must become stronger."

"You are already strong enough. Stronger than the last time, and the time before that."

"I must become stronger than that."

"For what reason?"

Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer, but Breaking the Sky Swordsman heard the answer.

Strangely, the two of them had the same face at that moment.

"It's strange."

"I don't understand it either."

"Well, it's time for my blunt disciple to make a friend."

"That's not the reason."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint smiled faintly at Yoo Joonghyuk, who shook his head. Then, her expression hardened for a moment and she asked.

"Are you thinking of entering the Time Fault?"

"Yes."

"I know what it means for you to enter the Time Fault."

To most mortals, the 'Time Fault' is a worthless darkness where nothing exists.

In the void where only the density of time is extremely concentrated, mortals test their limits and challenge transcendence.

However, some 'Time Faults' are different. There are stories within those Time Faults.

A Time Fault with a much harsher survival difficulty than a Time Fault filled only with emptiness, but one that offers unimaginable rewards if you can clear it.

"You must return to the world you failed to protect again."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint knew whose story that 'Time Fault' was.

"The more often you visit there, the more crazy you will become. No matter how strong your mind is, you cannot endure such things repeatedly."

"Still, I must go."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who confirmed that her disciple's determination would not change, asked with a light sigh.

"Yes. Are you going now?"

"Yes."

"Get ready. I will accompany you to the entrance of the Fault."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint asked again.

"Are you going to use the 32nd Fault this time?"

The 32nd Fault was the worst Fault that Yoo Joonghyuk had used in the 40th Round.

There, Yoo Joonghyuk gained the power to bring down even the stars.

"No."

Time that had fallen asleep like a fossil buried deep inside.

In some Time Faults, there were stories that even he had not experienced.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at the sky for a moment and opened his mouth.

"This time, I plan on going to the '40th Fault'."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 823 Episode 41 Sophistry (7)

---

What is a life written in text?

Someone's year can pass in a single sentence, and someone's life can be summarized in a single paragraph.

When I think about the lives of the characters, I sometimes feel such sadness.

Did I fully portray this character's life? In fact, couldn't I have told more stories? Is this scene really the 'highlight' of this life?

So where does the rest of his life, which didn't become the highlight, go?

"I'm bored."

Maybe this very moment is also one of the rest that disappeared in that way.

"You're just talking nonsense."

Three months after saving Yoo Joonghyuk from the Blood Cult group in the 40th Round.

I was thrown into the void with Yoo Joonghyuk.

To briefly explain what a void is, it's as follows.

[Hidden Scenario - Entering the 'Earth Void'!]

There is another world beneath the mantle of the Earth where we live. The cliff we fell from was one of the entrances to the common area.

The common area was a place where monsters of at least level 5 or higher - monsters that could easily rule as a single type of conqueror - gathered.

"Let's just hold on a little longer. Just count to 10 minutes in your head."

"If you keep talking like that, he'll find us."

We waited quietly until the level 2 monster, the 'ed dragon', disappeared.

It was absurd that the place we fell was the Red Dragon's nest, but on the other hand, it was fortunate.

After a while, the Red Dragon left to hunt, and we inspected its nest.

"We found it."

The Red Dragon's lava pond.

We could see a few fish swimming around inside.

Mannyeonhwari.

One of the most exquisite spirits in '0th Murim'. A spirit with an inner power that even the Transcendental Constellations and the Constellations of the Giant Nebula covet. I immediately caught the 'Mannyeonhwari' and carefully cut open its belly. The recipe for 'Mannyeonhwari' was written in detail in the 81st Round of 'Ways of Survival'.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was watching me work, said a word.

"That's not how you do it."

"No, this is the right way to do it. The magic usage is also correct."

"If you prepare it like that, you'll lose half of the Mannyeonhwari's internal energy."

"Instead, it makes it easier to consume. The patient should just shut up."

The reason I was cooking something I wasn't even good at was because of that damned guy from the 40th Round.

He barely survived by falling off the edge of a cliff, but because he was so severely affected by the intangible poison, Yoo Joonghyuk's internal energy didn't return.

"If you hadn't eaten my Blood Spirits, this wouldn't have happened."

"Yeah. It's all my fault."

After a while, the sloppy Mannyeonhwari dish was completed. Yoo Joonghyuk flipped the fish over with his fingers as if he was searching through a pile of trash, and left a short comment.

"It's trash."

"What? You haven't even tried it."

"I know even without trying it."

"No, then why didn't you cook it yourself?"

"You need internal energy to cook the Mannyeonhwari. And I can't use magic right now."

Yoo Joonghyuk swallowed the Mannyeonhwari while making all sorts of expressions.

Still, it was touching. In order to eat it, Yoo Joonghyuk had overcome his own myth that he 'can't eat things made by others.'

By the way, now that I think about it, I understand why Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho became so strong in the 40th Round.

Since they ate this kind of stuff every time, they must have ended up having incarnation bodies that even the stars would despise.

Thinking about it made me feel a little uncomfortable.

Could it be that Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho became so strong in the 40th Round because of me? Could it be that I, who am here now, intervened in the 40th Round through this 'Fear' and changed history? I don't know if this makes sense...

After a while, Yoo Joonghyuk, who was chewing on the Mannyeonhwari, muttered.

"My internal energy has returned a little."

It was the moment when the efforts of the past three months finally paid off.

Mannyeonhwari is Mannyeonhwari, but the number of spirits I've defeated in order to restore that bastard's internal energy must have exceeded dozens. I wanted to cheer right away, but I tried not to show it.

「I might be able to escape from the Fear now.」

Because if I showed it for no reason, the 'Fear' might detain me again.

This Fear didn't have a clear beginning and end.

However, if Fear is also a 'story', then there is definitely a beginning and an end. If my intuition as a writer is correct, the end of this Fear will be 'when Yoo Joonghyuk's internal energy returns in the 40th Round'. That's a fitting conclusion for a Round.

"That's good."

I said with a bittersweet feeling. If even a little bit of magic power had returned, Yoo Joonghyuk would now be able to repeat the [Recovery] and regain his former skills. To be exact, he would be able to absorb all the elixirs he had consumed so far and obtain a much more powerful incarnation body than before.

If that were to happen, escaping this cave would be no problem.

"I owe you something."

I was a little taken aback by Yoo Joonghyuk's unexpected remark.

Did I know that this kid would say something like that?

"Then pay it back."

"Understood."

"Yes?"

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned.

"Tell me what you need."

Yoo Joonghyuk's debt. This is precious.

I thought for a moment and then said this.

"I don't need it right now. Pay it back on the 41st Round."

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me as if he was dumbfounded.

"I forgot for a moment that you knew about regression. But I can't keep that promise."

"Why?"

"Because the next time you won't be the same you are now?"

"How do you know that?"

"When the next Round changes, everyone except me will return to the past. Memories will disappear, and history will be forgotten. Only a few lines of anecdote will remain."

Just 'a few lines of anecdote.'

"Why are you saying that so solemnly? Isn't that how our lives are?"

"What?"

"Some things are forgotten, and only the things that are remembered are remembered. They become scenes, sentences, and anecdotes. Even precious moments and sad moments will eventually remain as just a few lines of a story."

Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to think about what I said for a moment and then replied.

"Why are you saying that?"

"I mean, don't trivialize those few lines of a story."

Maybe it doesn't take that many sentences to change a life.

One line, and then another line. That one line, written with great difficulty, changes someone's life.

"Funny. To hear that from someone who doesn't remember anything."

"Yes. I'm sorry."

"Now tell me what you really want. If you keep talking nonsense, I won't repay your debt."

"Even if it's not the next time, you can't repay my debt."

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned again.

"What kind of nonsense are you trying to say again?"

"I'm not saying nonsense, I'm saying the truth. Let's say you repay the debt to me a month from now because you owe me now. Is the current Cheon Inho and the Cheon Inho a month from now the same person?"

"What—"

"Some people would say 'the same person'. Because there are so many 'stories' in the world that recognize them as 'the same person'."

"..."

"Then let's think about it this way. If I lose all the stories I have now a month later, and thus lose all my memories, is the current Cheon Inho and the Cheon Inho a month later the same person?"

"..."

"They look exactly the same, and their personalities are similar. They often talk nonsense, and they laugh unluckily with their eyes wide open. Can we say they're the same person?"

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk knows this contradiction better than anyone else.

He can't repay the debt he owes in this Round in the next Round.

The comrades who sacrificed themselves for him will never return.

He will be crushed by that debt of distant memories.

I looked at Yoo Joonghyuk for a moment and then continued.

"But you can do that."

"What?"

"You can think of the next Round's me as the same person. This guy has lost his memories, but he's the Cheon Inho I know. Think of it that way. And do to him like you're doing to me now."

"Why should I do that?"

"Then you won’t be alone either."

Yoo Joonghyuk’s eyes wavered as he paused.

I continued speaking.

"I'm telling you not to live like that, pretending to be lonely in the world, pretending to be the main character, pretending to embrace the darkness of the universe. What if people forget? Just think shamelessly on your own. That guy is the guy from the last Round. He forgot, but I remember. So I'll take revenge. Didn't you apply that standard to the villains? I'm a villain too."

Yoo Joonghyuk was silent for a moment.

The pond of the Red Blood Dragon began to boil, and soon several Mannyeonhwari jumped out and disappeared.

Suddenly, I had a question.

Do Mannyeonhwari know that they live in lava? Since they were born in lava, they probably don't even know that it's hot there.

"Even if I help you in the 41st Round, you won't gain anything from it now."

"Why won't I gain anything? I'm getting help in the 41st Round."

"What—"

"In my next life, I want to ride the Regressor bus and live comfortably."

Yoo Joonghyuk snickered as if it was ridiculous upon hearing that. Although it was a mockery, it had been a long time since I'd seen Yoo Joonghyuk laugh.

"You crazy guy."

"Are you the only one who's going to do it?"

I heard the sound of the nest shaking lightly. It was a sign that the red dragon was returning. It was time to leave now.

At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk said something unexpected.

"Cheon Inho."

"Yes."

"There's still a lot left until the 41st Round."

Yoo Joonghyuk wasn't looking at me, but I felt like he was looking straight at me more than ever.

"So?"

"I have no intention of giving up this Round easily."

The moment I heard that, I realized what Yoo Joonghyuk was trying to say.

"Help me in this Round."

Be his partner in the 40th Round. That proud guy was saying that directly.

I was captivated.

But the moment I met the eyes of the guy who was looking back, I was overcome by a strange feeling.

「What he's looking at isn't me.」

I was just an illusion created by this strange Fear, and what Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at was not Kim Dokja or Lee Hakhyun, but Cheon Inho's shell.

The person he was talking about becoming his comrade with right now wasn't me.

The moment I realized that fact, I felt something tangled in my head.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

Since it's already like this, why don't I tell Yoo Joonghyuk, who's in his 40th Round, some important information?

Even if I fail in the 40th Round, what if I just tell him everything I know so that he can change history in the 41st Round?

"Yoo Joonghyuk, my real name is—"

The moment I was about to speak, the world was filled with bright sparks. The Red Dragon running from afar disappeared, and the common scenery disappeared. Yoo Joonghyuk disappeared, and I disappeared.

In a world where everything was just a few lines of sentences, I shouted my name toward Yoo Joonghyuk.

[■■-level Fear, Chapter 1 of 'Evil Sophist' has ended.]

[You have made a decisive contribution to the completion of that Fear.]

Regardless of whether Yoo Joonghyuk heard it or not, the ending of the 40th Round was also recorded in just a few lines of sentences.

[You can now read the 'forgotten ending' of ■■-level Fear, 'Evil Sophist'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 824 Episode 41 Sophistry (8)

[The forgotten ending can be unlocked in 'The Last Bookshelf'.]

[When unlocking the ending, you can use the 'Time Fault' exclusive to that Round.]

The message coming into my head was not easy to understand.

The events that had happened up until then were buzzing around in my head. Words came to mind without any order.

Yoo Joonghyuk. Wild. Red Blood Dragon. Mannyeonhwari. Earth Void. 3 months of time.

The scenery swirling and scattering. Sentences breaking apart like lies.

It didn't feel real at all.

「Is it really all just 'Fear'?」

Did I really change the past? Or was I just seeing an illusion?

If I had changed the past, would my actions have affected the ending?

[■■The aftereffects of sudden Fear are creeping in.]

It was a long time before I realized that the phone was ringing. The sender is 'me'.

—Hey.

Who have I acted out so far? Are the lines I've spoken really mine?

Am I Kim Dokja? Or Lee Hakhyun? Or neither.

I am.

The 'One Who Deceived the Stars, the Evil Sophist, the villain of the Geumho Subway, the leader of the Iron Guard, the Rival of the King, the one who saw the end of the world line, the one who arrived at the Final Wall, the Recorder of Fear-

—Youngest!

I suddenly came to my senses.

"Ah—"

My mind cleared up and the confusion subsided. As my choked breath was released, I felt a little tearful.

—Yeah, good job.

I muttered in a dazed state.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. What happened to Yoo Joonghyuk?"

—What are you talking about? Where's Yoo Joonghyuk?

"Yoo Joonghyuk from the 40th Round. That guy was there."

—I know what you saw, but come to your senses. It's all over. The story is over.

Those words touched something inside me.

"No. Nothing is over yet."

Yoo Joonghyuk and I were there. We survived for three months in that damned room.

I saved him.

I was there.

—That Round was over.

I didn't want to admit it. If I reached out right now, I felt like all those moments would come back to me. The feeling of dismantling Mannyeonhwari still lingered in my fingertips.

—That Yoo Joonghyuk came to this Round with you.

I hesitated and looked down at my smartphone.

Was it okay to think that way?

Just like I told Yoo Joonghyuk, was I entitled to hear the same story?

Am I worthy of that?

"No, I—"

—You're the Youngest. Come to your senses quickly. Up ahead…

The phone was disconnected again. It seemed like we had entered a no-communication zone again.

I looked aRound and saw the faintly shining subway lights.

I felt nauseous again. I repeatedly creaked while holding the subway handrail.

[Your incarnation woke up in 'Subway on the way home from work'.]

The Fear was definitely over.

But why was I still in the 'Subway on the way home from work'?

The reason was clear.

[You have unlocked Chapter 1 of '■■-level Fear, the Evil Sophist'.]

This 'train' has not yet reached its destination.

[You have interpreted 'Uninterpretable Fear'.]

[Interpretation suggestion: A colleague who is separate from life and death]

[You are blessed with Fear.]

All 'Fear' affects the interpreter when successfully interpreted. Just as one story naturally blends into another story.

We will have to wait and see whether it is positive or negative, but for now, my body felt lighter. My field of vision also broadened.

「My 'Story' of seeing the world has leaped a step further.」

I savored that feeling for a moment and then suddenly looked around. There was someone who had collapsed in the seat across from me.

"Hey."

It was Anna Croft.

She seemed to have fallen like me, as she was slowly opening her eyes.

"Ah, ah... Cheon Inho. No..."

"It's okay."

Anna Croft's eyes widened.

I put my hand on her shoulder for a moment and calmed her down. If my thoughts were right, she must have been going through the same confusion as I was.

What kind of memories did Anna Croft see?

Did she get sucked into the 40th Round’s memories like me?

Anna Croft, who had been catching her breath for a moment, looked up at me. Her voice was trembling.

"A message saying that the interpretation failed has appeared."

The interpretation failed.

It was a different message from what I had seen.

"But since the one who got on the train with me succeeded in interpreting, it’ll give you another chance…"

Anna Croft’s eyes widened as she spoke.

"Cheon Inho, you—"

"Yes. I succeeded in interpreting."

"I owe you something."

It felt strange to hear similar words from Anna Croft after Yoo Joonghyuk.

Well, I didn’t mean to, but I would appreciate it if she thought of this as a debt. There was one thing I was curious about.

"What did you see in the Fear?"

Judging from the fact that Anna wasn’t in the 40th Round’s story I entered, she probably wasn’t involved in the same story as me.

So what kind of memories did she encounter?

"I don’t know. I don’t remember."

"Nothing?"

"Yes. Nothing. I remember hearing that I was unqualified."

Unqualified?

"I also remember seeing a message saying that the breakdown interpretation failed after that."

I thought for a moment and nodded.

Maybe this is the difference between those who succeed in interpreting Fear and those who fail. Those who cannot interpret Fear in their own way do not have memories of enduring that Fear.

"Do you remember what you said before you entered the Fear?"

I recalled what Anna had said to me just before the subway lights began to flicker madly.

"When you asked who I was, you said that I was one of Yoo Joonghyuk's closest colleagues. What did you mean by that?"

"I said that?"

Her expression seemed as if she could not understand that she had said that herself.

"It is true that you were once Yoo Joonghyuk's colleague, but... colleague? Wait a minute. That can't be... colleague...?"

Her red eyes filled with suspicion spun around fiercely for a moment.

The eyes of the Great Demon.

She had activated [Past Sight]. But the next moment, her... pupils became cloudy and light sparks flew out.

"Huh, what is this."

I thought I knew what had happened.

"Why [Past Sight]..."

The 40th Round where Yoo Joonghyuk, Cheon Inho, and Anna lived was now a 'record' that she could not read.

I wonder if it had something to do with my new interpretation of the Fear.

I couldn't tell if it was good news or not.

Of course, that wasn't the only thing I couldn't tell if it was good news or not.

"It's okay. You don't have to force yourself to see it. There's a bigger problem."

I looked around cautiously and said.

This wasn't the '3807' cabin that Anna and I had ridden in.

The bloody corpses of the incarnations were lying everywhere.

In other words, this cabin had already been hit by a 'Crime Zone' and someone had killed them all. Maybe the 'Final Passenger' had already been chosen by now.

The last one left would probably be Cheok Jungyeong.

Anna's voice trembled in surprise.

"Oh my god. If this happens..."

"It'll be okay. We approached Fear in a different way than others."

We didn’t use the 'Crime Zone', so our punishment will be different. That’s the rule of this 'Fear'.

The moment I thought that far, the door in front of me slowly opened. The car in front wasn’t the passenger car.

"Ah."

Han Sooyoung’s record flashed through my mind. If my thoughts were correct, this place was right in front of me…

「The Engine Room.」

I exchanged glances with Anna Croft and slowly stepped toward the doorway.

The moment I stepped inside the door, space swallowed us up.

A room painted pitch black. When I looked closely, what I thought was a pitch black wall was actually a window. A dark, terrifying universe was reflected beyond the window.

Several old monitors were installed in the room. A tall man was standing in front of the monitor that was emitting soft light.

That man must be the 'Engineer'.

My eyes met with the Engineer who slowly turned aRound. No, to be exact, I felt that way.

A shape with no mouth, nose, or eyes. A large question mark was floating above the Engineer’s face. The question mark was staring at me.

【Come in.】

The moment I heard his voice, I felt a strange sense of foreboding.

A fragment of a story stabbed my head with a tingle.

「A foolish human being does not know that the throne of God is high.」

At that moment, I felt Anna’s body standing right next to me stiffen.

【That friend will stay like that for a while. Because she is not worthy to hear my voice.】

The dot on the question mark grew longer on both sides as if smiling, and then twitched like lips.

【By the way, it’s been a long time since I’ve been in 'seon' for three months. Thanks to you, I had a little fun.】

On the old monitor, the three months that Yoo Joonghyuk and I had experienced were occasionally flowing out.

I watched the screen with the Engineer for a moment.

I had something I wanted to ask.

"Did what I experienced really happen?"

【I just told you, you were in 'Seon'.】

Seon. A term for a sleep that is not deep.

"Then I dreamed?"

【Well. How different do you think dreams and reality are?】

"I don't know, but dreams are dreams and reality is reality. They are not the same."

【Who decides that?】

"Yes?"

【If this entire universe is someone's dream, and everyone in the dream lives without knowing it, is it a dream or reality?】

I was speechless for a moment. I thought I understood what he was talking about.

The Engineer looked at me for a moment and added.

【Most of this universe is made up of that. It is not us who decide whether it is a dream or reality.】

"The Oldest Dream."

The Engineer flinched at my answer.

I thought for a moment and then added.

"For someone who dreams all their life, that dream is also reality."

The Engineer laughed heartily as if my answer was interesting.

【I saw a man talking like you a long time ago.】

It was clear who he was talking about.

I took a deep breath and opened my mouth.

"Chief. Could it be that you are…"

I thought.

Just as <Kim Dokja Company> did, Asmodeus did, the Mass Producer did, and Uriel did, there might be 'more' similar cases.

Even though they saw their own 'end', the Constellations still weren't satisfied with the ending.

I slowly looked aRound the engine room. After thinking about it several times, there was only one person who could come on this 'train'.

A star who was once Kim Dokja's nemesis, and a star who drove the train for <Kim Dokja Company> at the last moment.

His modifier was—

【Shh. I am now the 'Fearsome Engine Manager'.】

Watching him place his finger on the question mark's lips, I hesitated and asked.

"Are you okay?"

The engine manager seemed to understand the meaning of my question and was silent for a moment before nodding.

【I am satisfied with my role. Driving the train is my specialty.】

I wonder if a constellation that has fallen in love with a story can never leave its side even after the story ends.

I looked at the great Lokapala of <Veda> who once shone brighter than anyone else for a moment and asked.

"What are you going to do with me now?"

【This is the 'Subway Home from Work'. If you woke up in the captain's seat, you should arrive at your destination now.】

Destination.

【It's my job to take you to your destination. Where do you want to go?】

It seems that the 'Subway Home from Work' was a kind of means of transportation in this 'Fear'.

I thought for a moment and then opened my mouth.

"Where I want to go."

The place I wanted to go was a place that couldn't be reached by 'public transportation'. It wasn't a place that could be reached by running fast.

It took time to get there. It took a story. I had to go through terrible hardships and overcome several deaths.

A place that even Kim Dokja, who had endured such a long time, couldn't go to in the end.

【I see.】

The Engineer looked at me and nodded as if he knew my destination.

【You want to go to the 'Big House'.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 825 Episode 42 Destination (1)

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「"When the scenarios are over, we can all live together in a big house?"」

—Shin Yoosung, <Kim Dokja Company>.

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What kind of scenery comes to mind when you hear the words 'big house'?

I think of a living room.

In that living room, there is a large fireplace (not a real fireplace), a chandelier that swings slightly overhead, and several long tables and sofas.

People are sitting at the table reading books or sitting on the sofa chatting away.

And in the middle of them is Kim Dokja, holding a smartphone.

He is holding a smartphone, but it is hard to tell whether he is reading a novel or not.

His expression is not very visible. He seems to be smiling, or he seems absorbed in something.

But he looks stable. He looks more comfortable than ever before.

Recalling that comfort, I mustered up the courage to open my mouth.

"Yes. I want to go to a Big House."

The 'big house' I had in mind and the 'big house' Kim Dokja had in mind were definitely different. The 'big house' that I could imagine was <Kim Dokja Company>'s—a somewhat artificial, modern-style living room.

"Can I go?"

I don't know what that place was like. However, I had to go to the 'Big House'.

That's because I heard that 'Second Kim Dokja' was there.

The Fearsome Engineer stared into the darkness of space for a moment at my answer.

【As you know, the train is not a means of transportation that goes directly to 'home'.】

"Then…"

【But I can take you to the nearest station.】

The Engineer added, placing a special emphasis on the word 'station'.

【Don't you know? Some destinations cannot be reached in one go.】

I understood what the Engineer said.

That was certainly the law of this <Star Stream>. The reason why Prisoner of the Golden Headband, who was able to bring the scriptures from Cheonchuk in one go by riding the Somersault cloud, had to go through all kinds of hardships with his party.

The reason why Kim Dokja, who was able to debut in the <Star Stream> in one breath by choosing a strong sponsor, had to become a Constellation himself instead of choosing a sponsor.

"Just getting to the station is enough."

That's because this world needs stories.

"As long as that station is close to the destination."

【Only you can decide the distance to the destination.】

The Engineer continued, tapping the instrument panel with his finger.

【Will you walk slowly with more Constellations, or will you advance quickly with the few Constellations that only like you?】

I thought for a moment about who the 'Constellation' he was talking about was.

The Engineer's questioning lips formed a small smile as he looked at me.

【I'll get you to the station as quickly as possible. I've received a reasonable fare.】

"Did I pay the fare?"

【You showed me an interesting dream.】

I belatedly remembered that he too was once a Constellation.

【It has been a long time since I have been so absorbed in a story.】

The voice of the Engineer mumbling like that contained a strange longing and passion.

At least for that moment, he was not the 'Chief Engineer of Fear' but the 'Final Chief Engineer' Surya who had seen his own fate.

I stood next to him and stared into the vast universe of Fear.

Where is his Destination?

Is he challenging the [Last Wall] with <Kim Dokja Company> once again? Or is he continuing to replay the ending of an event that has already happened?

Or is this eternal journey in Fear itself his Destination?

A life where the story itself is the purpose.

When I think about it, Kim Dokja was the same.

The ■■ that 51% of Kim Dokja reached was 'Eternity'. The ending that he chose, who was more curious about the ending than anyone else, was a story that never ends. Instead, he left the 'End' to the other Kim Dokja. And in a sense, his end has not yet been realized.

If the 'End' is completely written, will Kim Dokja be happy?

I don't know. The essence of my soul is a fragment of Kim Dokja, which is less than 0.1% of the content.

I, who am like that, have no right to decide Kim Dokja's happiness.

But maybe I, who am like that, can help Kim Dokja choose happiness.

That's when the smile disappeared from the conductor's expression.

【It seems that someone has been chasing you.】

The subway shook dully with a thud. Something was biting and shaking the tail car of the subway. At first, I thought it was a 'Tooth Fin,' but upon closer inspection, it wasn't.

The area beyond the tail car was being eaten by something.

An unprecedented fog covered the back of the train.

I realized what had been chasing me.

【Is it a piece of Indescribable Distance?】

The cleaner of the <Star Stream> that devours everything that goes against probability.

It was definitely it. It was the powder of the 'Nameless Mist' that Jaehwan-nim had stabbed and disintegrated. It had somehow recovered its strength and crossed over to this 'Fear'.

The Engineer's lips twisted into a question mark as if it was quite unpleasant.

【It's been a while since a train broke apart.】

If I think about it, Surya's train was eaten by Outer Gods in the main story as well.

As if he couldn't let it go like that this time, the Engineer increased the train's speed.

【Hold on tight. I'll drop you off at the stop right away. Oh, and take that friend next to you as well, too.】

My body trembled and I shook anxiously. The scenery around me began to quickly flow by.

Suddenly, I thought that this might be the last time I would see him.

I wanted to ask him something as I looked at his large back guiding the way. But no appropriate question came to mind.

【The commute home from work is extremely rough.】

Why did I end up crying without realizing it? Do I have the right to be crying at those words?

【It takes more stories than you think to arrive at the Big House safely.】

"You should come with me."

Only after saying that did I realize that was what I really wanted to say.

The director paused for a moment and then said without looking back at me.

【You're so mysterious. You can still say that.】

"I'm nothing. I'm nothing compared to the Kim Dokja you remember."

I didn't intend to say that.

Even so, the moment I heard him say that, I let out a weak sound.

Maybe it was because of Fear.

While experiencing the 40th Round of Fear, 「The Evil Sophist」, something in my heart might have broken down.

I felt anxious that I wouldn't be able to do things like Kim Dokja or Cheon Inho. Maybe it was because of that weak heart that I asked Surya to go with me.

【Unfortunately, my tale cannot reach your ending.】

I know. He is not a character of this world line. His ending has already ended.

"Can I go all the way?"

I didn't want to ask that question. I wanted to ask how to reach the 'Big House'.

And the Fearsome Engineer told the passenger who had said the wrong destination the correct location of the destination.

【A tree fell in the forest where no one was.】

"Huh?"

【No one saw the tree fall, so the tree's fall has not yet been recorded in this universe.】

I suddenly thought I knew what he was talking about.

The origin of this universe is text, and what is not recorded does not exist 'yet'.

And what does not exist cannot change the world.

【Just like you did to me, find the fallen trees again and read them. Record them. Then...】

The train shook even more violently.

I instinctively grabbed Anna Croft's arm and reached out to the Engineer.

【The 'Big House' will definitely find you first.】

The scenery disappeared.

[Disaster-level Fear 'Subway on the way home from work' has been successfully interpreted.]

[Interpretation suggestion: As long as the stars do not forget the story, the story will never lose its light.]

[You have obtained the 'Story Fragment Selection Ticket' as an interpretation reward!]

[Exploration of the Fear Realm has increased!]

[Current exploration of the Fear Realm: 57%]

When I blinked again, Anna Croft and I were outside the train. The cold air brushed against my nose. Surya's train, shining like a star across a distant galaxy, was leaving with a particle of 'Indescribable Distance.'

Will we ever meet again?

I carried the unconscious Anna Croft on my back and looked up at the long tail of the train for a moment.

—Youngest.

The phone call connected again.

It was Kim Dokja.

—There is no time to be absentminded like that. Open the guide quickly. It seems that the additional descriptions of the guide written by Han Sooyoung were unlocked at the same time as the interpretation of 'Subway on the Way Home from Work'.

I quickly turned on my smartphone and checked the contents.

And I found a strange description.

> This Fear is mainly observed after the 'Middle Area'.

It was an additional description related to the Disaster-level Fear 'Tooth Fin'. There was another additional description.

> This Fear is mainly observed after the 'Middle Area'.

The Fear I encountered along the way, about 'Alien Traffic Lights'. And.

> This Fear was only observed after the 'Middle Area'.

Including 'Subway on the Way Home from Work'.

All three of the Fears I encountered so far had descriptions of the same content added.

「All of the Fears that appear after the 'Middle Area'.」

So the difficulty of the Fears was extremely high.

No, wait a minute. Then this.

Kim Dokja's voice was heard along with the fear that was slowly rising.

—Remember when you first read the rules?

I checked the 'Fear Exploration Guidelines' again. Then, the damn rule I had forgotten came to mind clearly.

> —Warning. One of the 'Exploration Guidelines' above is 'false'.

It clearly said so in the Exploration Guidelines.

At first, I was wondering what the heck was false in the guidelines, but now I think I know.

> —You are currently located in the Entrance Area of the Fear.

"This was a lie."

If this was a false guideline, then everything I've experienced is explained.

Not only that, but it also makes sense that there were no survivors from the 'Fear Expedition' for the past three rounds.

They all started their exploration in the 'Middle Area' like me, and were wiped out by an unexpected Fear.

[A new Fear has been unlocked.]

[Unlocked the 'Modifiable Manual', a Catastrophe-level Fear.]

[Increased Fear Exploration level!]

[Current Fear Exploration level: 63%]

Even this 'Exploration Guideline' was scary.

I expected it.

The problem is that you can't defend against everything just because you expected it.

Gooooooo.

The place I fell was the ruins of a city center.

My desire to ask where this place was and my desire not to know where this place was clashed.

A thick white fog covered the ground. The torn arms, legs, and torsos of the incarnations were scattered here and there. Some were of a martial artist, and some looked like the incarnations of Constellations.

Beyond the fog, I saw a strange creature with eight long legs walking. The creature slowly moved its head as if searching for prey, and then started moving its legs again.

I asked, holding my breath.

"What on earth is that?"

There wasn't just one creature.

A creature with a long, thorn-like head that wiggled.

A giant boar-like appearance. A creature with twelve horns growing out of its body that carried corpses in a row. A giant baby that pushes everything in sight like a bulldozer.

—Divine beings of another world.

That’s right. Those were definitely 'Divine beings of another world'.

But why are there other-worldly beings wandering around here?

— Doesn’t that sound familiar?

"I wish you hadn’t said that."

— But this is my Second taste. I can’t help it.

"Damn it."

I knew a similar scene.

Foreign reporters and nameless things wandering around. Familiar signboard letters rolling on the floor. A statue of Yi Sunsin split in half and a broken throne.

「A scene that looks like a part of Seoul cut out in the 1,864th round.」

Beyond the distant fog, the outline of the 'Industrial Complex' where <Kim Dokja Company> lived was vaguely visible.

[You are currently located in the 'End Zone' of the Fear Realm.]

Maybe the 'Big House' of the Second Kim Dokja might be a little different from the place I imagined.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 826 Episode 42 Destination (2)

I thought for a moment about the tastes of the Second Kim Dokja.

Severed octopuses and squid legs were writhing on the floor, and to the west, a huge group of babies were passing by, destroying buildings.

To the east, a mad boar with water was running wild, and to the south, an Outer God was swaying.

I don’t even want to talk about what’s in the north.

If this is a 'Big House', then I just want to live in a small house.

—The north is the worst.

Our First Kim Dokja also left a brief sigh.

That’s right. No matter where you look, east, west, or south, the worst Outer Gods are inhabiting, but the worst of them all was the north.

"That, that’s it, right?"

—That’s it.

But Kim Dokja’s Industrial Complex is in the north, and to get there, you have to go through that.

—If you want to go, then go for it.

"You have to cheer me on."

—It would be better to just wait for the Second One to come out of the house.

"Shall we call out loud?"

—Would a hikikomori come out just because of that?

[NOTE 1]

We stood there blankly for a moment, looking up at the Outer Gods blocking the northern path.

In the main story, the Outer Gods—the existence of the 'Divine Beings of the Other World'—were often mentioned.

A representative Outer God among them. The 'Divine Beings of the Other World', a member of the 'Old Beings' and the librarian of [The Fourth Wall] in the 1,864th Round.

Why is that guy here and not some other guy?

Fortunately, there was a description of him in the guide.

*Some parts of this document have been modified by SVRP.

SVRP. PW 01864.

Natural Disaster-Level Fear - Dream Eater

One of the ancient Gods belonging to the 'Old Beings'. Has the characteristic of exploring the dreams of mortals. It is known to often trade rare dreams or knowledge with dreamers from other dimensions.

…According to the claims of the Transcendents, the 'Dream Eater' that appears in the End Zone is a shell with its original soul removed.

It is said that it wanders the northern part of the End Zone with only its instinct to seek out dreams remaining, for an unknown reason.

…

A mutation related to the 'Final Wall' was reported in a certain Round. It was confirmed that the incident in that Round affected the rest of the world line.

There have been no additional reports since then.

…

Confirmed to maintain the level of Natural Disaster even after its original soul was lost.

The fact that only a shell remained means that its essence was absorbed into the [Fourth Wall].

I stared blankly up at the body that stretched vertically several kilometers into the sky. It seemed slightly smaller than what was depicted in the main story, perhaps because it had lost some of its original power… Even in that state, it was a 'Natural Disaster-level' monster that was enough to destroy a world.

Interestingly, there were those who fought against that 'Natural Disaster-level' monster.

[Move! Attack from the legs!]

What's more interesting is that all the Constellations that moved the incarnation were guys I knew.

[The Constellation 'Spear Master' is furious!]

[The Constellation 'Kwon-gak Taoist' scatters powder!]

[The Constellation 'Filth Addict' vomits filth!]

'Kwon-gak Taoist', whose torso burst after being hit by the leg of the dream eater, cried out in pain.

Spear Master. Kwon-gak Taoist. Filth Addict.

That must be it. They were all Constellations that I had fought at the 'Recycling Center'.

Constellations that had possessed upper-level demons and blocked my path.

Some of them must have died at the hands of Yoo Joonghyuk, and some of them I must have dealt with... Anyway, I have to recognize the tenacity of the Constellations.

[Damn it, I can't come all the way here and die!]

[Spear Master! Isn't that different from what I heard? Much more difficult than the End Zone we know…]

[Find the Time Fault! Quickly! If we just go in there…!]

[Where are the Transcendent Alliance guys? Why are these things running around and I can't even see their noses!]

[Filth! Ooooooooooo!]

In the midst of the chaos, the words of the spells came and went. From what I heard, it seemed like they had come all the way here to find the Time Fault.

It wasn't strange.

The Master of the Spear also had experience training through the 'Time Fault' in the past.

They probably came here to make up for the defeat at the 'Recycling Center' and to open up new realms through training.

[Joint attack! Clear the way! If we definitely get to that Industrial Complex—]

Unfortunately, it seemed like their luck ended here.

Ooooooooooooooooo.

A scream that sounded like an entire world was screaming.

The 'Dream Eater's' legs moved. The legs raised as if launching a missile descended toward the ground without hesitation. The movement that contained more than simple physical force caused the ground to collapse and an aftershock erupted.

The sound of something colliding. The screams of the Constellations. A huge amount of dust that covered the sky black.

I hugged Anna Croft and fell to the ground.

It took a few minutes for the dust to settle. There were no living beings left in the scorched earth scene.

My body slowly began to tremble.

This was the Outer God that reached the 'Old Being'. Even if only the shell remained, its innate status was incomparable to that of any Constellation.

[This is… how can it go…]

A faint mantra. I saw the incarnation of the Master of the Spear, deeply embedded in a nearby building, hanging limply.

The other two were crushed by the legs, and there was no trace to be found.

I moved my trembling legs while carrying Anna Croft.

I had to run away right away. I have to go a little further. But where? Where can I run to in this apocalyptic land?

Ooooooooo.

The Dream Eater let out a strange roar and wiggled its body.

Was it my imagination? I felt the giant legs moving towards me little by little. Did it find me?

Or maybe.

"Cheon Inho. What the—"

"Shh."

I put my finger on Anna Croft's lips, who had just woken up.

Of course, simply holding my breath or not speaking wouldn't get me unnoticed.

I could feel it.

The guy would definitely find us. The disgusting story rising from his body spread like smoke as he searched the surroundings.

I thought for a moment and then said to Kim Dokja.

"Please lend me the story."

—Take it.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' responds curtly.]

There was a story of Kim Dokja that was passed down to me through 'Heir of the Eternal Name'.

Anna Croft, who was observing me like that, asked me in a whisper.

"Cheon Inho. Who did you just talk to?"

"A hyung I know."

"A hyung you know?"

Come to think of it, Kim Dokja used this 'story' next to Anna Croft in the main story. What a strange coincidence.

[The story 'Pebble and I' begins its storytelling!]

Pebble and I.

A story that Kim Dokja obtained when he visited the 'Island of the Reincarnations'.

The function of this story is simple.

[The effect of the story makes your presence similar to 'pebbles'.]

[The story 'Pebble and I' is suspicious of Anna Croft's existence.]

"Please take care of this person too."

[The story 'Pebble and I' looks at you with a displeased face, saying, 'This person again.']

[The story 'Pebble and I' shared its effect with 'Anna Croft'.]

That's it.

Now Anna Croft and I will be recognized as nothing more than a stone rolling on the side of the road.

Ooooo—?

Fortunately, the story worked normally, and the 'Dream Eater' didn't find us.

I quickly strode through the ruins, holding Anna Croft's wrist.

"Wait a minute, if we go that way now—"

"We have to go."

Instead of running away, we approached the main body of the 'Dream Eater'. It was a possible choice since its presence was fading.

"While the story continues, we'll pass it and approach the Industrial Complex."

A simple yet reliable strategy.

My liver grew colder as I approached the main body of the thing, but now was not the time to be picky.

As I passed the mouth of the thing's huge body at such a fast pace, I felt as if the thing's eyes were glancing at me from the vast sky.

—Youngest, I think you've been caught.

I reflexively shouted as I heard Kim Dokja's voice in my ear.

"Run!"

With my signal, we started running with all our might. Feeling the [Way of the Wind] wrapped around my toes, I immediately asked Kim Dokja.

"Why did we get caught? Did you give me a bad story?"

—I had forgotten for a moment, but that story is only applicable to beings who share the symbol system called 'stone'.

Come to think of it, the Gods of the Other World had a different symbol system from us in the first place. Their methods of communication are different, and their methods of signifying this universe are different.

Wait a minute, that means.

—That bastard, he wasn't fooled from the beginning.

Immediately, the guy's tentacles began to doggedly chase us.

Kudududududud!

A pitch-black shadow fell over the entire nearby area. If this continued, we would be crushed to death before even reaching the Industrial Complex.

"Hyung."

—Is this the only time you call me Hyung?

"Can I use the [Fourth Wall]?"

Now there is only one way.

The method used by Kim Dokja in the main story. A crazy way to trap his mind inside the [Fourth Wall] after he's been eaten by that guy on purpose.

— Didn't you read the guide? His soul is gone. He's just a shell. That won't work.

"But you won't know until you try. If he eats me, there might be a way."

If someone heard that, they'd say it was a crazy conversation.

Anna Croft was actually looking at me like I was crazy.

— Even if that method worked, it's uncertain whether the [Fourth Wall] would be able to accept him.

"You just don’t want to live with him, do you?"

— Do you know that the library you created is much more unstable than the original [Fourth Wall]?

"Is that so?"

I asked back, flinching slightly.

In reality, the [Fourth Wall] I have now is somewhat weaker than the original Kim Dokja’s. It's because I haven't collected enough 'Kim Dokja Fragments'.

—What do you think will happen if we fail to get that guy inside the wall? Me, but what about the other brats in this library?

Damn it.

I didn't think that far ahead.

Then we need to change our tactics.

"Anna! Faster!"

Anna nodded, her mind suddenly snapping to her senses at my shout.

The tentacles were now right behind us, and the complex was still too far away.

Thank goodness there were a few 'Fears' we could use along the way. For example—

[Catastrophic Fear 'Alien Traffic Light' activates.]

[Use the Story Fragment 'Remote Signal Controller'.]

I entered the crosswalk and changed the signal to green.

And the moment the 'Dream Eater' entered the crosswalk following me, the signal quickly changed to red.

A moment later, something rushed and collided with the tentacle of the 'Dream Eater' who ran the signal. An unbelievable collision that left skid marks.

Ooooooooo!

How is that, kid? The taste of civilization.

[The Natural Disaster-level Fear 'Dream Eater' roars!]

Perhaps the rules of the world only function because civilization exists.

That's why traffic lights and warning signs were useless in the face of a 'Natural Disaster' that would destroy even that destiny.

I hurled curses at the tentacle monster chasing me, ignoring everything.

"Follow the signal, you idiot!"

"Cheon Inho, were you talking to that monster?"

"Don't bother me and read the future, quickly."

"I still don't have [Future Sight]..."

"Why on earth are you so useless?"

Anna Croft muttered in confusion, as if she had never heard such abusive language before.

"Your ability is not limited to [Future Sight]."

"Yes. Of course."

Was she stimulated by my words?

Anna Croft suddenly became serious and activated 'Eye of the Great Demon' again. She was trying to use [Future Sight] again.

Tsk tsk tsk!

The sparks flew up fiercely. I was going to tell her not to overdo it, but Anna Croft did not turn off the skill even though she was shedding tears of blood.

As I watched the blood evaporating in real time from the sparks and drying up on her cheeks, I couldn't help but say a word.

"Tragic Fear, Anna Croft."

Anna Croft glared at me as if I was joking right now.

I was going to tell her that it was time to stop, but Anna Croft wiped away her tears of blood and said.

"I saw it."

"Yes?"

"I saw the future. Just a little bit."

I hesitated for a moment and asked.

"Did I die?"

"Did you want to see that kind of future?"

"No. I didn't die, did I?"

"Yes."

I grinned.

"That's enough. Good job, Anna."

The method I'm going to use from now on is at least a 'method that won't kill me'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Hikikomori; someone who avoids going out, a shut-in.

# 827 Episode 42 Destination (3)

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I said, pulling Anna Croft back.

"I'll take over from here."

"I can fight too."

I glanced at Anna. Her face was stained with shame. Perhaps her pride was hurt.

"I know. You're strong, But not now."

Anna Croft was definitely a person with incredible growth potential. If only a little more time passed, she would grow into a being that even the Historical-grade Constellations, or even the Narrative-grade Constellations, would have difficulty handling.

But that was only the latter half of the 'Ways of Survival'.

The enemy before us now was a monster that could annihilate three Historical-grade Constellations in one blow. It was definitely not an enemy Anna Croft could handle.

"You know, since you've seen the future. It's my turn now."

As if she already knew what I was going to do, Anna didn't act any more. Instead, she searched through her bosom and handed me a small leather water bottle.

"Drink."

"What is it?"

"It's my blood."

I opened my eyes wide.

Anna Croft's trait was 'Elixir Maker; Her blood itself is comparable to a high-quality elixir.

"Was giving this to me also included in the future?"

Anna Croft, her shoulders slightly shrugging, answered bluntly.

"Aren't you going to take it?"

I smiled and opened the cap of the bottle.

"I always end up drinking your blood whenever I meet you."

"This is only the second time."

Was it because my sympathy with the Demon King of Salvation had deepened? The moment I drank Anna's blood, Kim Dokja's stories lit up brightly and warmed the muscles of my entire body.

I felt the 'Dream Eater' looking down at me from above.

I thought as I faced that distant gaze.

How many more monsters like that are there in this Fear Realm?

—Coming.

I nodded and activated [Way of the Wind]. I flew high into the sky, avoiding the tentacles of the 'Dream Eater' flying towards me.

—You know this is a method that no one in their right mind would ever try, right?

"Have we ever been in our right minds?"

Kim Dokja's laughter flowed out from the other end of the phone. With that laughter as accompaniment, I flew up to the distant sky. My entire body's muscles were ticklish. The

stories inside me were trembling.

—It about time to fight properly.

The banished penalty was completely restored by obtaining the main scenario.

In other words, now is the time to test 100% of my strength. After all, I am the successor to the name of the 'Demon King of Salvation'. Even though I cannot fully display his power, I am not weak now.

Geeeeeeeeeing!

The 'Blade of Faith' rose from the sword of 'Unbreakable Faith'. As I swung the long sword vertically, pitch-black stories poured out from the surface of the tentacles flying towards me. The blow was minimal, but I didn’t care. It was just the beginning.

[Exclusive skill 'Way of the Wind Lv. 10' is activated to the limit!]

When the knots that Lycaon had told me about became entangled in the sword, the wind soon became my will.

[Baekcheong-ganggi began to flow along the wind knot.]

I ran towards the main body of the thing with my sword stuck in its tentacle leg.

「Way of the Wind dug into the surface of the wound and met Baekcheong-ganggi, causing large and small explosions.」

Ooooooooh!

This time, there must have been a slight blow, and I felt the 'Dream Eater' flinch.

—Did you apply what you learned from Lycaon?

"Yes."

The next moment, the 'Dream Eater’s' legs shook greatly and soared into the sky. It was definitely the attack that had sent the three Historical-grade Constellations to the goal earlier.

—Don’t hold back from now on.

Kim Dokja's words were right. From now on, if I don't give it my all, I'll die.

A fierce storm blew from the distant sky. Kim Dokja said, watching the tentacles of the thing falling at an incredible speed.

—If this doesn't work, you'll really die. You know that, right?

"Anna told me I wouldn't die."

—Do you believe that?

"I have to believe it now."

—Let's get started.

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. 11 (+1)' is activated!]

Originally, even if I used [Incite] or [Bookmark], it would have been impossible to compete with the 'Dream Eater'.

But now, if only for a little while, it might be possible.

Just because I went into the Fear of the '40th Round' once and came out, the power of my incite had changed.

"I—"

Of course, the person I would [Incite] was already decided.

"I am Goryeo First Sword Cheok Jungyeong!"

It wasn't just [Incite]. [Sentence Reinforcement] is a basic skill, and [Incite] is fully imbued with the know-how of Cheon Inho learned in the 40th Round.

「He was born a warrior. He was born with the blood of a dragon.」

The 'Heart of a Low-level Dragon' that I swallowed one day was beating like crazy.

「"He's too strong. Exile him from the scenario. Use all means at your disposal to send him to another world."」

A scenario exile with the blood of a dragon.

The attributes matched and dramatically increased the assimilation rate of [Incite].

「I can imitate him better than anyone else right now.」

[Item Blood of the Elixir Manufacturer's' is sensitive to your breath.]

Anna's blood flowed through my veins. The probability required for [Incite] was being realized by consuming Anna's blood.

「What I want.」

I am the best swordsman of Goryeo.

The best warrior of Goryeo who cuts everything with only one sword.

「Just cutting the emptiness before my eyes.」

The lines he had said, the lines he would have said. The history he had lived and the history he would have lived were tied together and embedded in my right arm.

The moment the magical power that had swelled to the point of bursting inflated, the tentacle legs of the 'Dream Eater' were right in front of me.

—Youngest.

"I am Cheok Jungyeong."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' begins its storytelling.]

[The story 'One Who Killed an Outer God' begins its storytelling with the effect of 'Heir of the Eternal Name'!]

Kim Dokja's story activated right on time. It was the very tale that Kim Dokja had obtained when he hunted the 'Dream Eater' in the Dark Castle.

With my heart pounding as if it was going to burst, I swung my sword at the tentacle.

Please, please—

Tsk tsk tsk tsk.

And the scenery before my eyes began to ripple. It was clear what it was a sign of.

「Staging.」

「Incite had just succeeded in deceiving the stage.」

「This is a sword that can cut a thousand people with a single sword.」

First Form, One Sword That Cuts Thousands.

A trajectory in the air collided with the falling tentacles along with a burst of magical power.

Kudududud!

But as expected, an Outer God is an Outer God.

A shockwave that even Cheok Jungyeong's single sword could not block was pushing First Form back.

—One more time!

I immediately activated the second sword.

Second Form, Two Swords That Cuts a Mountain.

Cheok Jungyeong's second sword to cut down a mountain. As the sword strike of a different dimension from the single sword was added, the shockwave emitted by the tentacles was canceled out in an instant.

An ecstatic sensation surged through the fingertips holding the sword.

「This is the power of a Transcendent.」

A supreme realm that only those who have shed their mortal skin and ascended to the Transcendent Realm can sense.

I thought for a moment. What if I could re-enter the '40th Round'?

If only I could experience that re-experiment over and over again, like Yoo Joonghyuk and other Transcendents who entered the Time Fault.

How strong could I become?

Kkuddeok.

That was when I instinctively felt something was wrong. A terrible pain seemed to run through my right arm, and then something rattled under my shoulder.

—Damn, it broke.

The frail incarnation body couldn't withstand the shock from the two swords.

[The effect of the exclusive skill 'Incite' is forcibly canceled!]

[The exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is activated, neutralizing the 'Incite Penalty'!]

To make matters worse, even [Incite] was canceled. I smiled bitterly as I watched another tentacle descend from the air.

—Not yet.

I thought I could use the Three Swords. Even if 「Staging」 is activated, I can't use the stage to kill that 'Dream Eater' right now.

In the first place, the 'Dream Eater' wasn't killed by Cheok Jungyeong's sword.

"Still, this is enough."

This is enough.

Instead of trying to resist death, I closed my eyes while watching the falling tentacles. And I imagined Cheok Jungyeong's three swords that I couldn't use.

The Third form, the Three Swords That Cut the Sea.

When I slowly opened my eyes while imagining that infinite sword power.

「This is a sword made to deal with the sea.」

I heard the tentacle flying toward me split in half with a cool wind.

With a sound of "Ooooooooh," the 'Dream Eater' burst out his mantra.

A man who didn't give in to that terrifying mantra stood before my eyes.

He was a Constellation who didn't Fear Outer Gods. The last passenger on the 'Subway Home', and a great disaster who caused the 'Crime Zone' and wiped out all other incarnations.

All my 'stages' up until now have been an action to draw out the interest of that person that is somewhere in the Fear Realm.

"Goryeo Swordsman. It is an honor to meet you."

Cheok Jungyeong looked back at me.

[You, how do you know my swordsmanship?]

His three swords are not a beginner's technique, but a technique created through thorough enlightenment.

It was familiar to me who was familiar with the story, but it was a martial art that ordinary martial artists could not imitate even if they tried.

But a mortal, who he was seeing that martial art for the first time, used it.

[Wait. Could it be that you...]

Oh, it's not the first time you're seeing it?

[I see. I've seen you fight Cheongae.]

Come to think of it, I had forgotten that the confrontation between Cheongae and Dragon Head Arc was broadcast on the Star Stream.

[That's interesting. I never thought that the kid from back then would come here.]

"It's an honor to be with you."

What was it about my words that made him feel good? Suddenly, Cheok Jungyeong burst into a grand laugh.

[This is the first time someone has learned my martial arts.]

If it were an ordinary warrior, it would be right for him, who knew his own unique martial arts, to question me.

I listened to him a little nervously.

[It was a single sword that was not enough to cut a thousand, and a double sword that was too short to break waves.]

A philosophical and precise analysis, but his tone was strangely gentle.

[However, that swordplay clearly points to that supreme universe. You must have learned the 'Three Swords Style'.]

Fortunately, Cheok Jungyeong didn't seem offended by my imitating his martial arts.

No, to be exact.

[Hmm. Good.]

He seemed to be feeling a little better.

The best warrior on the Korean Peninsula lightly patted his chest and declared.

[I will take you as my disciple from now on.]

Huh?

I heard the 'Dream Eater' shouting, "Ooooooh."

Before I could answer, Jungyeong moved. He cut down a thousand lives, and a mountain.

The warrior who cut the sea again swung his sword at the Outer God.

【Ooooooh!】

A martial art that was truly shocking. Cheok Jungyeong's sword slashed mercilessly at the 'Dream Eater', and the 'Dream Eater' also repelled all of the attacks with incredible agility.

Kim Dokja, who had been silently watching the spectacle, left a short comment.

—I didn't expect this.

"That's right."

—I didn't want it to turn out like this.

"Why on earth did you say something like that?"

Usually, they would have first investigated the circumstances of the leak of the Dokmun martial art or gone through some complicated procedure. However, that bold Constellation immediately took me as its disciple.

— Cheok Jungyeong is a Constellation that has never taken a disciple. His martial art cannot be learned through ordinary training.

"Ah."

A martial art that cannot be learned even if taught. But a human who mastered that martial art himself appeared.

—Well, there's nothing wrong right now. At least as long as Cheok Jungyeong thinks of you as his disciple, he won't let you die in vain in the Fear Realm.

Is this really a situation where I can just think that way and move on?

—Why, is there something bothering you?

The moment I was about to answer, someone's cold hand grabbed my wrist. It was Anna Croft.

"Cheon Inho."

"Yes. You want to run away?"

"Then you plan on dying here?"

"You said I won't die."

"I didn't see what happened next."

Anna's advice was right. Now is the time to retreat. While our master fights hard, we can quickly run away to the Industrial Complex and plan for the future.

—What a great disciple.

"Who did I learn from?"

—You know that even the best swordsman in Goryeo can't defeat the 'Dream Eater', right?

"Then this will be the last meeting between the master and the disciple."

I briefly bowed to the master who was fighting fiercely for his disciple from afar, and then turned back toward the Industrial Complex with Anna Croft.

But.

—This will definitely be our last meeting.

When on earth did he appear? The Outer God 'Yeongasi' who had been guarding a different direction until the war was blocking the way to the north.

It seemed that he had seen our fight with the 'Dream Eater' and had already approached us.

Anna Croft, whose face had turned pale, slowly hid behind me and said.

"I don't like Yeongasi."

[NOTE 1]

I didn't have much magic left anyway. So.

I quickly turned around and shouted loudly.

"Master! Your disciple is in danger!"

Then the master replied.

[If it were my disciple, he could take care of someone like that by himself.]

Hmm, it seems that the new master is the type who pushes his disciple into the tiger's den.

I started to slowly back away with Anna.

"Is there another plan?"

"No."

Anna Croft tilted her head at my desperate answer.

"That's strange."

"What do you mean?"

"It wasn't the Goryeo Swordsman."

"What do you mean?"

"What I confirmed in the future was that it wasn't the 'Goryeo Swordsman'."

While I was wondering what that meant, I heard a conversation from somewhere. It was on the rooftop of a nearby building.

"Hehe, the Captain of the Third Division fights with the Dream Eater every time he comes here."

"What a pitiful guy."

"Let's subdue him first. We'll attack the Dream Eater together, and who will fight Yeongasi?"

"I'll do it."

The moment the Yeongasi monster rushed in with a "Kwaeaeaeaek," a blue sword strike rippled before my eyes.

I knew what that martial art was. The blue of the sword resembling the clear and bright sky.

—Wow, it's been a really long time.

Baekcheong-ganggi. But that wasn't my Baekcheong-ganggi. A sword much more noble and even beautiful than my Baekcheong-ganggi.

"That's him."

As Anna spoke, I looked at his back as if I was possessed. His sky-blue hair, which matched Baekcheong's swordsmanship, was blooming brilliantly in the dazzling light.

As I watched the Yeongasi Outer God running away screaming, I suddenly recalled the description of him when he first appeared.

「In 'Ways of Survival', when describing a handsome man, the expression 'slapping Yoo Joonghyuk's face' is often used, and I would say he is a person who fits that expression perfectly.」

If I were to express my emotion right now, Yoo Joonghyuk's cheek would be gone.

I finally ran towards the 'real master' who had appeared.

But the expression on the master's face as he looked back at me was unusual. Now that I think about it, why is that? Master's appearance was a little strange. No, it wasn't just a little strange.

That... what is that?

Was Kyrgios originally that big?

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Yeongasi means 'parasitic worm' or 'controlling ghost' in Korean.

# 828 Episode 42 Destination (4)

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The most memorable sentence among the descriptions of Kyrgios Rodgraim, the White Blue of Paradox, is this.

「The beginning is a single point, so the smallest is the greatest.」

There's also this.

「The strongest small person in the world.」

Do you see what's repeated?

That's right.

「Small.」

That was Kyrgios's alpha and omega, his core element.

A Transcendent being from Peace Land, where only tiny people live together. He even overcame his complex of 'smallness' and reached a particularly great enlightenment.

That's how the Kyrgios I knew was.

So how should I explain the man I see before my eyes right now?

"Disaster-level Fear... White Blue of Paradox?"

"Cheon Inho, are you really crazy?"

No matter what Anna Croft said, I had no intention of taking back what I had already said.

Because there was no other way to explain it than 'Fear.' If the smallest is the greatest, how should we interpret Kyrgios, who has grown a little… no, a lot? Should we see him as having become a little less great?

Of course, our teacher, who is still great even if he has become a little less great, was walking lightly toward me with his characteristically dignified steps.

—I've seen all sorts of strange things after living a long time.

Leaving behind Kim Dokja, who kept spouting nonsense toward the true teacher, I finally faced Kyrgios, who had arrived in front of me. It was a moment that made me feel quite tense.

I had a history of pretending to be Kyrgios' disciple and betting on Baekcheong-mun's name while dealing with the Dragon Head Arc of the Beggar Sect at Seoul Station.

Maybe, just like Cheok Jungyeong, it's possible that Kyrgios knows me.

It was a situation where I could end up in trouble if I made a mistake with my tongue, but even so, all I could use was my damn tongue.

"White Blue of Paradox, Kyrgios Rodgraim. Is that right?"

"Who are you?"

"Yes. I am..."

What should I say?

Should I say Kim Dokja?

While I hesitated, Kyrgios asked again.

"How do you know that martial art?"

Come to think of it, I was still activating [Baekcheong-ganggi].

It was already too late to release the skill, and since it had come to this, I had no choice but to go with the 'Kim Dokja Strategy'.

"I'm late in greeting you. A disciple outside the Baekcheong-mun clan is meeting the elder of the clan."

Kyrgios looked down at me blankly and said.

"Baekcheong-mun clan has already been destroyed."

"I know. I learned from the last survivor of Baekcheong-mun clan."

It wasn't exactly a lie.

In fact, I learned [Baekcheong-ganggi] from someone who had mastered it secretly.

"I've heard a lot about the master. I've always wanted to greet you properly someday, and I'm honored to meet you like this."

I thought I was being polite, but Kyrgios's reaction was strange. I glanced around and saw several people who had appeared with Kyrgios muttering.

"The Captain of the First Division is still popular."

"Is it Kyrgios again?"

"I told you. There are a lot of people who want to become that friend's disciples."

There were a lot of people who wanted to become disciples?

—Oh.

The moment I heard Kim Dokja's voice, I got goosebumps.

I'm an idiot. Why didn't I think of that?

—It seems there was one here too.

The readers of this world possessed various people in various places. So wouldn't there have been readers who possessed others near Kyrgios?

"Is your name 'Kim Dokja' too?"

I smiled bitterly.

Fortunately, unlike the other Kim Dokja, I had a way to prove myself.

"You're the first to learn [Baekcheong-ganggi]."

Thinking about it, it was natural.

In this world, I and LiteraryGirl64—Cha Yerin were the only ones who learned [Baekcheong-ganggi].

—You survived thanks to Yerin.

Her name suddenly came to mind and I felt a strange longing.

I wonder if Yerin is doing well. What happened to Killer King? Ji Eunyu or Dansu ahjussi. And Kyung Sein…

A voice from behind interrupted my short thoughts.

"Kyrgios. That's it."

A man was walking towards me from a distance with his upper body naked. It was Goryeo's best swordsman, Cheok Jungyeong, who had been fighting the Dream Eater until the war.

"That pale little one is my disciple. Don't let your eyes lightly fall on him."

"Your disciple?"

Cheok Jungyeong patted his chest again at Kyrgios's question full of doubt.

"Yes. He is my disciple. Judging from your reaction, it seems you have recognized the talent of the little one."

"..."

"But it's too late. He is my swordsman."

The two people's gazes were subtly intertwined in the air. At that moment, when I wondered what was happening, a loud noise rang out from far away.

Kukukukukuku!

Ten Transcendents were surrounding the Dream Eater and attacking together.

At least the power of a 'Spear Master'.

When they gathered together and performed a passing technique, even that powerful Outer God staggered and retreated.

It was an unbelievable sight.

No matter how strong the Transcendent were, they were not enough to defeat that 'Dream Eater'?

"Tsk tsk, that's not how you cut."

"…"

"Hey! 2nd Division rookie! You have to stab faster! Do you want to get stuck in the Time Fault for another hundred years?"

"…"

"No, that's not how you do it!"

When did it start? A small old man standing right next to me was lecturing them. To me, it was just an amazing martial art, but it seemed to be nothing special in the old man's eyes. The old man added a few words to the combined attack of the Transcendents for a while, then suddenly turned to me.

"Huh? Who are you?"

"Oh, me."

"A newbie?"

The atmosphere of the old man laughing vainly felt familiar.

What should I say? He seemed like someone who had long since transcended the 'scenarios' of this world.

The old man glanced at me with profound eyes and let out a small exclamation.

"There are only a handful of newbies who have come up here alone, but you're quite a guy."

"What's your name?"

"I'm Kim Dokja."

The old man smiled in an unknown way at my words.

"That's a strange name. I like guys with strange names."

A feeling of longing flashed across the old man's expression as he spoke.

Soon, I saw the 'Dream Eater' retreating with a gurgling sound from afar.

When I saw Kyrgios and Cheok Jungyeong standing in their center, my heart started pounding for no reason. Perhaps there are still many stories in this world that I do not know.

Those who do things that even the Constellations cannot do with their human bodies.

The old man looked at them and said.

"Kim Dokja. Welcome to the 'Transcendent Alliance'."

---

Transcendent Alliance.

"No, wait a minute!"

I was captured by the Transcendents and dragged straight to the Industrial Complex.

The building that I thought was Kim Dokja's 'Big House' was surprisingly their headquarters.

[Disaster-level Fear, admitted to the 'Fear ward'.]

I was even dragged to the ward and given a blood transfusion of stories.

I looked at Anna Croft, who was hospitalized next to me, and asked.

"Are you okay?"

"I'm okay. How about you?"

"Do you think this looks okay?"

"I don't know what the situation is."

It seemed like it was a situation that even Anna Croft's [Future Sight] couldn't see. It seemed like she was trying to activate [Future Sight] several times, but the situation wasn't going smoothly.

Maybe it was natural. If I were to guess, we're 'very close to the Second Kim Dokja'.

Yes, this is the 'Big House' you were thinking of, Kim Dokja.

"What do you think the purpose of capturing us is?"

"Well. If they didn't mistake us for 'Fears'..."

My smartphone was buzzing at that moment, so I checked, and the guide had been updated.

* Part of this document has been modified by SVRP.

SVRP. PW ???

Fear of a Natural Disaster—Transcendent Alliance

An alliance of Transcendents residing in the apocalyptic region. An organization formed by super-strong individuals, each of whom is equivalent to a Constellation.

■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■

A few particularly powerful Transcendents are called 'Captains' and are known to each possess a level of danger equivalent to 'Genius Payout'.

Total Captain, ■■■■ ■■

Zero Brigade Captain, ■■■■ ■■.

First Brigade Captain, Paradoxical White Blue Kyrgios Rodgraim.

Second Brigade Captain, Breaking the Sky Namgung Minyoung.

Third Brigade Captain, Goryeo Swordsman Cheok Jungyeong.

…

> In all the Rounds where the group appeared, they were observed to have fought against the 'Great Old Being' and been annihilated.

I was honestly surprised while reading the guide's explanation.

There were two reasons why I was surprised.

One, there were people I knew who were happy to be alive in that terrible 'End Zone'.

And two, they were ultimately annihilated by the 'Great Old Being.'

The Great Old Being. There were some names of Outer God that came to mind, but I couldn't figure out what kind of being they were fighting against and being annihilated against.

[Disaster-level Fear, the effect of 'Fear Ward' is activated.]

My eyes kept closing.

[All your wounds will be healed.]

It seems that this is the effect of this ward.

I heard someone screaming in my head several times. I couldn't tell if it was my scream, Anna's scream, or someone else's scream.

When I opened my eyes again, it was already morning.

A large man greeted me.

"Are you awake? Disciple."

Cheok Jungyeong was there, smiling with his teeth exposed.

---

I was introduced to various places in the Transcendent Alliance by Cheok Jungyeong.

It seemed that the Transcendent Alliance only used the first floor of the 'Industrial Complex'.

Cheock Jungyeong spoke in an unusually kind tone and explained in detail the sleeping rooms, bathrooms, and training rooms in the building.

"And from today on, you are the youngest of the Third Unit."

"Hey, Master."

"Why are you doing that?"

"I didn't say anything about joining the Transcendent Alliance."

I couldn't understand. All I had been through for a day was being forcibly admitted to the ward.

But I was forced to become a member of the Transcendent Alliance as soon as I was discharged?

Cheok Jungyeong's lips twitched slightly, perhaps because my reaction was unexpected.

"Disciple. Didn't you come here because you wanted to become a Transcendent?"

"That's true."

Becoming a Transcendent was the only way for me to become stronger now.

However, I didn't come here to become a Transcendent and die. I didn't know when the 'Great Old Beings' would attack, but if I stayed here, it was only a matter of time before I would die with them.

"If you work hard here, you can become a Transcendent. Just like this body."

"Isn't the Master a Constellation?"

"For someone as strong as me, such a concept is not important."

I decided to interpret the situation positively.

Anyway, I have to find the 'Second Kim Dokja' here, and this is the safest place in the End Zone.

Will the Great Old Being attack? No. Can't I just run away before the attack?

And most of all.

"Okay, that's it."

Here, I can use the 'Time Fault' that I've only heard of.

"It's the famous 'Time Fault'."

In a space wider than a playground, small doors were densely packed in all directions. In front of the doors, there were small monitors attached, and the scenes that quickly flowed inside the monitors seemed to be videos taken inside the Time Fault.

In some monitors, there was an incarnation exploring the edge of darkness, and in others, there was an incarnation that fell from the bridge forever. I could also see the Constellations trapped in Tartarus, the Prison of the Underworld.

Everyone was struggling in different places, different times.

I could also see the numbers attached to each monitor.

2-3 Rounds. 4-11 Rounds. 5-33 Rounds. 6-77 Rounds…

"What are these numbers?"

"Ah, that’s it."

Cheok Jungyeong scratched his cheek and answered.

"I think it’s probably the order in which the Time Faults were created, but I don’t know exactly."

I checked the scenes on the monitor and sank into silence.

Cheok Jungyeong’s thoughts were right in some sense, and wrong in some sense.

And only I understood what that 'Round' was.

Yes. Those Time Faults—

「They’re all Yoo Joonghyuk’s 'Regression' Rounds.

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 829 Episode 42 Destination (5)

---

The 'doors' of the Time Faults that covered the entire space and filled up to the very top of the sky.

I approached the closest door.

"Hey, disciple. Don't go in. There's a passenger there."

I looked at the door that said [2-1 Round]. The number '2' in front of it probably meant Yoo Joonghyuk's world Round.

And the '1' behind it...

[Currently, the scenario 'Proof of Value' is in progress.]

Is it a scenario number?

The monitor hanging next to the door showed a scene from the subway.

It was a scene I knew very well.

—Kwaaaaah!

—Save me! Save me!

A woman with cold eyes was sitting in the scene of the First Scenario that repeated forever.

I knew it without anyone telling me. She was the 'Passenger' of that world.

"That guy said that's where she fits best."

"…"

"The difficulty of the Fault itself is low, but it is a place with high fatigue, so it has a unique character."

According to Cheok Jungyeong, all Transcendents enter the Fault of their choice, spend time, and repeatedly practice to achieve enlightenment.

Some Transcendents achieve enlightenment by repeating the same actions or scenarios, while others experience overwhelming time and raise their level.

"In my opinion, that guy is halfway crazy. She must have forgotten that she has to come out again by now."

In fact, some characters seemed to have forgotten that they were experiencing repeated scenarios in the Time Fault.

For example, the Transcendent that entered [6-21] looked quite serious at first glance. His pupils were weak, and saliva was dripping from the corner of his mouth. No matter how you looked at it, he was a person with madness.

"If you don't come to your senses, that's what happens. After all, that 'Time Fault' is also a 'Story'."

"If I don't live the story, the story will live me."

Cheok Jungyeong's eyes widened at my answer.

"Wow, disciple. You know some pretty good words. It's just like the invincible snake that always says."

"Shouldn't we go and save those people?"

"They probably don't want to be saved."

"Why?"

"Even though they look strange from the outside, they might be in the process of achieving enlightenment."

Enlightenment? That? No matter how you look at it, it looks like they've gone crazy.

"You can't know what's going on in their head, right?"

Well, that might be true.

Even if they're drooling on the outside, they might be in the process of leaping to a state of profound enlightenment on the inside.

If that's the case, you'll probably get cursed at later if you try to save them.

"And there are many cases where you can't enter at all because the number of people allowed to enter is limited to one. That Fault just now was the same."

Upon closer inspection, [6-21] had a limit of one person allowed to enter.

That means that even if that person were to go crazy there, no one would be able to save them.

"Anyway, entering the Time Fault is their own choice. There's no need to feel pity when you see them all. Rather, it's an insult to them."

I felt a little lonely as I watched the Transcendent drooling in the darkness.

The people who threw away their entire lives just to become stronger.

What made my feelings more complicated was that the place they threw their lives was that 'Time Fault'.

Maybe all Transcendents are ultimately a kind of Yoo Joonghyuk. Or maybe they want to be Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Can I go in too?"

"It seems like you're interested now."

Cheok Jungyeong chuckled as if he knew that would happen.

"But not yet. You haven't taken the 'Fear Suitability' test."

"Fear Suitability?"

"As you can see, most of those who enter the Time Fault cannot maintain their incarnations. Well, there are exceptions. For example, if there is an identical 'incarnation' within that 'Fault', that's an exception. Like that old man."

The place that Cheok Jungyeong pointed to was [Round 16-59]. In the screen of that Round, there was a boy who was practicing while sitting cross-legged in the hellfire.

I immediately recognized who that boy was.

The invincible Yoo Hoseong.

He was the master of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

In the main story, he was on the "Island of Reincarnation", but in this Round, he chose to reside in the Fear Realm.

Cheok Jungyeong continued to speak.

"Anyway, depending on how high your Fear Suitability is, the type of 'Time Fault' you can enter also changes. That's talent here. No matter how powerful a Transcendent is, if your Fear Suitability is not right, you can't enter."

"I see."

"The suitability test is tomorrow. I'll tell you what you have to do then, so go in and get some rest today."

I nodded, but even after Cheok Jungyeong left, I didn't leave right away and just stared up at the distant Time Faults.

I don't know why the 'Time Faults' came into existence. However, I had one guess.

"That bastard Kim Dokja… How much have you read?"

This world ultimately exists through Kim Dokja's 'reading behavior'. That means that these many 'Time Faults' could also be the results of Kim Dokja's 'reading'.

For example, those abnormally split memories might be the result of Kim Dokja 'rereading' the world from time to time.

Just like opening a page of a book to read when he remembers it, Kim Dokja might have read, read, and read this world again.

I thought as I counted the endless number of Time Faults.

Second Kim Dokja.

What are you looking for in this distant past of Yoo Joonghyuk?

---

The next day, I took the 'Fear Suitability' test. I don't know why so many captains came to a rookie's suitability test, but my masters were among them.

"I'll find out if you're qualified to be a Baekcheong-mun."

"That's all for finding out. My disciple! Ignore what this parasitic brother says!"

Kyrgios and Cheok Jungyeong were still fighting, and.

"You're here, Cheon Inho."

Anna Croft, who had been waiting at the location in advance, greeted me and said.

"Are you here to take that strange test too?"

"Yes. What."

"Is it a mun test?"

[NOTE 1]

"..."

"If the test results lead to being kicked out of the Fear or something..."

Anna Croft had currently betrayed her nebula and fled here. If she were to be chased out of the Transcendent Alliance right away, she would have nowhere to go.

I looked at Anna for a moment and said this.

"Don't worry."

"How could you..."

"You said it. Your ability is not all about [Future Sight]."

It is true that Anna Croft is an incarnation specializing in 'Information Warfare' compared to other named incarnations.

But that doesn't mean she has no talent in other areas.

Anna Croft, who had been quietly staring at me, slightly opened her eyes and turned her head.

"I didn't know you'd say that, but..."

I smiled.

Well, sometimes, there are days when a villain like me can cheer others on.

In this way, Anna Croft has a cute side.

After a while, the Commander-in-Chief approached us.

"Nobu is called the God of Despair."

[NOTE 2]

The Commander-in-Chief of the Transcendent Alliance was that old man. That is, the person who told me, 'Welcome to the Transcendent Alliance.'

By the way, the God of Despair...

I've heard that nickname a lot somewhere.

"The test itself is simple. Just read the sentences written on the blank paper I gave you."

Anna Croft was the first to receive the paper. It seems that the sentences on the blank paper will appear when the test starts.

Cheok Jungyeong, who was watching me from afar, waved his hand and shouted.

"Jeji, don't be so intimidated Mira! Even reading just one word is amazing!"

"You're a newbie who's finally here, but you should at least read one line."

"If you're a disciple of Baekcheong-mun, you should be able to read two lines."

"Shut up, Gisaeng Brother."

[NOTE 3]

Amidst the leaders' scorn, Anna's test began first.

"Ah."

Did a sentence appear on the blank paper?

Anna's brow furrowed slightly.

A spirit of despair blew.

"Can you read it?"

Anna Croft nodded, and a light rustle arose among the meadows. It seems that being able to read that itself is an amazing thing here.

Anna Croft took a deep breath and slowly opened her mouth.

"The first sentence written in space."

An awkward pronunciation, as if reading an unfamiliar foreign language.

Anna tilted her head a few times and slowly finished speaking.

"The first sentence was Ini."

Then the paper shook lightly, and a dazzling ring of light flowed out and hovered over Anna's head for a moment. It hovered. A short silence flowed. When Anna, who was burdened by the silence, slowly raised her head, the God of Despair took a step closer and asked.

"Can you read the next one?"

Anna Croft lowered her head again and stared intently at the blank paper. One minute, two minutes passed like that.

Anna shook her head with an uncertain expression.

"No. I don't know."

"I see. You passed."

A light exclamation of admiration erupted from the Transcendents.

"Young friend, you're really good."

"It's been a while since I've read the first sentence. When was the last time?"

"Didn't Goryeo Swordsman read even one sentence?"

"I read it too, you bastards."

It seemed that reading an entire 'sentence' in the Fear Suitability test was an extremely rare case.

"It's not easy to read the first sentence... If you're at that level, you could be put into a 'Natural Disaster level Fear' right away."

"Arthur. Are you going to replace all the new recruits again?"

"You grow by bumping into things."

"Hey you! Apply as you are!"

The one who calmed down the noisy Transcendents was once again the God of Despair.

"Now, now, be quiet. The test isn't over yet."

The God of Despair then handed me a blank sheet of paper.

To be honest, I felt strangely excited rather than nervous when I received it.

What could be written on it?

An item that didn't appear properly in the main story or even in the 'Ways of Survival'. Maybe this 'blank sheet' contained a hint about the 'Second Kim Dokja'.

After a while, a sentence appeared on the paper.

I stared at the sentence carefully and carefully read the first sentence. It was the same sentence that Anna Croft had read.

"The first sentence written in the universe wasn't the first sentence."

The moment I read the first sentence, a ring of light flowed from the paper and hovered above my head.

Once again, exclamations were heard from those around me. "What, you read it again?"

"As expected, it's my disciple!"

I blankly looked down at the paper. Anna Croft couldn't see the next sentence.

Why... can I see it this well?

"All sentences are nothing more than fleeting dreams, and the order of dreams is determined only by the dreamer."

With each additional sentence, the ring of light hovering over my head began to grow.

"Some dreams are short, some are long, some are deep, some are shallow. Some are pitiful, some are great, some are sublime."

Before I knew it, silence had taken hold of the surroundings.

I continued reading the story, echoing the silence.

"All those dreams cannot become a single old dream, so there must be a place where the abandoned dreams gather."

As I read, I realized little by little.

I see, this is it.

"There must be a very big house beyond time and space, unfettered by the laws of dokkaebis. There, all dreams are free as Fear. In the snowy fields of incomprehensible dreams, the King of Fear will smile, neither light nor darkness."

A story about the 'Fear Realm'.

And.

"But every story has an ending, so one day, those who wish to record the end of Fear will come."

A story of those who wish to record that Fear.

"The Fear that has begun to be recorded will return to being a tale. It will become a set story. It will be recorded in history again."

The moment I read that far, someone muttered.

"Wait a minute. Is it okay to keep reading that?"

"Disciple! Stop! If you read to the last sentence—"

But it was already too late.

I couldn't take my eyes off the paper, and my mouth was only functioning to read the sentence on the paper.

"When that day comes, the boundary of sleep will open, and the King of Fear will descend. And only he who defeats the King of Fear—"

At last, I finally said the last sentence.

"At the border of dreams and reality, he will become the last storyteller who denies all records."

When I slowly raised my head, I could see three rings shining brightly above my head.

The pale-faced Transcendent Legion spoke to me.

"My God, there's someone who can read all of that?"

"That kid's Fear Suitability is…"

"For God's sake, Chunghuh! Is that okay? If you're not careful—"

And then, as if it had been waiting, a message spread through my head.

[You have unlocked an Unknown Fear.]

It seems that this 'paper' was also a kind of Fear.

The problem was the message that came next.

[You have interpreted the 'End-level Fear', 'End-level tow truck'.]

What level?

[Interpretation suggestion: Fear Realm, go down, Second Kim Dokja, open the door.]

[The countdown to the 'End-level area' begins now.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Here 'mun' could mean either written test or spirit test, they both sound mun depending on context.

Note [2]: 'Nobu' Could mean 'old man' in Korean but I am not sure so I left it like this.

Note [3]: Gisaeng were highly trained female performers skilled in music, dance, poetry, and conversation, who often served royalty, aristocrats, or high officials.

# 830 Episode 42 Destination (6)

Since that day, my nickname has become 'End'. It makes sense, because the next day, a countdown started to appear above my head.

[Time remaining: 28 days 3 hours]

This is the same no matter how you look at it.

28 days 3 hours later, this 'End of Fear Realm' will be destroyed.

"Hey, that kid said he ended the end of the End of Fear?"

And I'm the crazy guy who pressed that destruction button.

"Is it true that you unlocked the End-level Fear?"

"Wow, I really have to live long enough to see this. That paper was all read?"

But I feel wronged, too. What did I know? I just like reading.

I read it because I'm a reader.

"So that paper can't be used anymore?"

"What did you get in return? If you had interpreted it, you would have gotten a reward."

Reward. Of course I got a reward.

[Acquired the Story Fragment 'Murim Dumpling Recipe'.]

Honestly, I wondered if this was the reward for interpreting the 'Final Tale'.

Then on the other hand, I thought it might be a valuable Story Fragment.

As far as I know, this recipe is now out of print.

I'll give it to Yoo Joonghyuk later when I meet him.

"Kim End-nim."

When I turned around to see who came to pick a fight again, Anna Croft was standing in front of me with two cups of coffee. It was a refreshing sight.

"Yes, Kim Anna-nim."

"You look free."

Now, openly picking a fight, Kim Anna handed me the coffee.

The coffee I drink in the Fear room tastes much more bitter than the coffee I knew.

Of course it is.

This is 'Fear coffee'. It's black water with a strange setting that temporarily increases your immunity to Fear when you drink it.

"Yes, I'm so free, my head's going to explode. Is the work worthwhile?"

It's been three days since I entered the Fear Realm. In those three days, Kim Anna, who entered the first unit, has already been deployed to five 'Time Faults'.

"Yes. It was better than I thought."

Although she is still a newbie and has never been deployed to a Time Fault alone, Anna Croft's recent activities have been a hot topic within this lonely 'End Zone'.

In particular, because her [Future Sight] worked accurately in some Time Faults, the reputation of the 'Prophet' among the Transcendents is once again on the rise.

"You look happy. As if you got a job at the company you wanted."

"You're mistaken."

Anna Croft added, her face hardening in a hurry.

"But Cheon Inho. You haven't been assigned to any missions yet."

"Well, I'm just so great."

Before I was even assigned to the Time Fault, I unlocked one 'End-level Fear', so the Transcendents couldn't possibly be happy about me. If they were to assign it wrong and unlock another 'End-level Fear', it would be a big deal.

So the fact that I'm stuck in the restaurant right now is a kind of disciplinary action.

This is what a new employee who got into trouble right after joining the company does.

I'll say it again, I'm also wronged.

Who wanted to do that?

And the company I wanted to work for wasn't the <Transcendent Alliance>, but <Kim Dokja Company>.

"Our Captain asks a lot about you."

If it's the Captain of the First Division, it's Kyrgios Rodgraim.

"So you told him that I'm the worst villain you know?"

It was a joke to make people laugh, but Anna's answer was unexpectedly serious.

"You're the one who keeps destroying the common sense of 'future' that I was certain of. I said that."

For a moment, I just touched the poor coffee cup, wondering what to say. Anna Croft really seemed to care about me.

"So come to your senses. You don't plan on letting the 'End Zone' be destroyed like this, do you?"

I nodded.

"I don't plan on that either. The problem is that there is a lack of hints on what to do to prevent the End."

After joining the 'Transcendent Alliance', I lost contact with the First Kim Dokja, so I couldn't ask him anything over the phone.

Well... It's not like there were no clues to interpret it at all.

「When that day comes, the boundary of sleep will open, and the King of Fear will descend.」

If my guess is correct, the 'King of Fear' mentioned in the prophecy of the end refers to 'the Second Kim Dokja.'

How do I know?

「In the snowy field of incomprehensible dreams, the King of Fear will smile, neither light nor darkness.」

'A smile that is neither light nor darkness.'

Anyone can see that it is an expression meaning 'the Watcher of Light and Darkness', a modifier of the Second Kim Dokja.

My question starts here.

Then why does the 'Second Kim Dokja' appear in the prophecy as the 'King of Fear'. And why does the prophecy refer to his appearance as the 'Prophecy of the End'.

Everything was full of questions.

Would the world turn upside down just by the appearance of the Second Kim Dokja?

"Isn't that a little strange?"

I asked back indifferently.

"What's strange?"

"If that prophecy is true, this 'End Zone' will be destroyed in exactly 28 days."

"Of course."

"That's what's strange."

"So what is it?"

"The countdown to the End has begun, but look at those people."

I looked at where Kim Anna had pointed. The cheerful-looking Transcendents were standing in line, filling their plates with dumplings. In a way, it was quite a sight. The losers of a world that even those Constellations couldn't touch were standing in line to receive their dumplings.

Even Cheok Jungyeong was shouting in a brazen voice, "Master! One of these dumplings is smaller than the others!"

"The dumplings must be delicious."

"Cheon Inho. Do they look like people who are about to end?"

"Those people are Transcendents."

"Even if it's a Transcendent, it's an 'End-level Fear'. I asked the Captain, but he said that the 'End-level Fears' that have appeared so far have never been properly resolved."

Hasn't it ever been resolved?

"He said that the End-level Fears can only be accepted. That's why it's the 'End', and a Fear that no one can avoid."

If it was Kyrgios, who had grown so tall, and not another Kyrgios, who said that, then it must be true.

"Then why are those people so cheerful?"

The clever Kim Anna looked at me with pitiful eyes at my question.

"I think that's something you should figure out."

"Why? Please help me."

"It's something that I can't see even with my [Future Sight]. However..."

Fortunately, our Kim Anna seemed to have caught on to something.

Kim Anna, who was watching the steam rising from the restaurant, slowly opened her mouth.

"When I look at them, I feel like they've already experienced 'destruction' once."

I listened to Anna's words and blankly stared at the backs of the Transcendents.

Among them were the Goryeo's First Sword Cheok Jungyeong, who was more aggressive than I remembered, and Kyrgios, who had grown much bigger than I remembered.

In addition, I saw the Commander–God of Despair, Chunghuh, who was watching them from afar, and the Young Byeondae and Il Byeondae Vice-Captains guarding him.

I stared at them for a moment and then said,

"That's good advice."

"Huh?"

"They've already experienced 'destruction'."

To Anna Croft, who was wide-eyed, I smiled like Kim Dokja and added,

"I think I've found a clue."

---

Deep inside the first floor of the Industrial Complex where the Transcendent Alliance resides, there is a 'Time Fault Room'.

The very room that Cheok Jungyeong had first guided me to.

The Young Byeondae Vice-Captain, who happened to be guarding the room, greeted me.

"New recruit. Are you here again?"

"Yes."

"There are no 'tasks' to give to the new recruit today either."

"It's okay. I just came to look around."

The Transcendent Alliance has 'tasks to solve' every week.

For example, it goes like this.

「Eliminate the Disaster-level Fear 'Backstepper' that appeared in [2-16 Round] (incomplete).」

「Eliminate the Disaster-level Fear 'Dragon Eater' that appeared in [22-14 Round] (currently in progress).」

「Eliminate the Natural Disaster-level Fear 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' that appeared in [124-24 Round] (currently on hold).」

According to the Transcendents, these tasks were a kind of earthquake that occurred in the 'Time Fault'.

The Otherworldly Deities, Outer Gods, or Fears that were wandering around the <Star Stream> would wander around looking for a place to hide and become parasites in the 'Time Fault', and from there, problems would occur throughout the Fault.

The Transcendents of the Transcendent Alliance were in charge of eliminating such strange phenomena and managing the 'Time Fault'.

—Kuoooooo!

On the screen, I could see Cheok Jungyeong cutting off the head of the 'Dragon Eater'. It was a refreshing swordsmanship worthy of Goryeo's First Sword.

—He's a guy who drank a lot of dragon's blood, everyone, take out your alcohol. Today, I'm going to make a special Yonghwa wine and drink it!

Since I'm a member of the Third Squadron, I should have gone on that hunt. However, after the 'End of the Fear' incident, I was restricted from entering the Time Fault, and thanks to that, all I could do was look at other Faults here.

Well, there's nothing I can do. Since the Transcendents say I can't, I can't force myself into the Fault.

So what have I been doing these past few days?

"Are you trying to watch the video again?"

"Yes."

"You won't get stronger from watching it."

"I'm just a little interested."

In this Time Fault room, you couldn't only see the 'Time Fault' currently in progress. In short, I could also view the cases of the 'Time Fault' that had already been resolved.

For example, the one I chose was,

「[42-16th Round] The Disaster-level Fear 'Darkness that Descends' (Complete)」

Darkness that Descends. It was an Outer God's name that I didn't know well. However, I knew very well who had defeated it.

Baekcheong's swordsmanship that was dazzlingly displayed on the screen. Indeed, it was a skill that gave me goosebumps whenever I saw it.

"Huh? Rookie! Are you watching our Captain's video?"

When I turned around at the noise, I saw familiar faces standing there.

The First Platoon Leader and the Commander-in-Chief—'God of Despair Chunghuh'.

"Yes. I was watching it because it was on the viewing list."

The First Platoon Leader asked with a bright face at my answer.

"Isn't our Captain incredibly strong?"

"He is incredibly strong."

"The Captain still talks about you a lot these days. How on earth did you possess our Captain?"

I looked up at the face of the chattering boy. Although he looked like a boy on the outside, it was clear that the First Lieutenant was also a Transcendent who had lived for a very long time.

The boy's name was Ryunard.

He was called the 'Naked Saint' because he always fought naked.

"You shouldn't trouble a newbie, Ryunard."

The one who intervened was the one guarding the room.

The Captain of the Young Brigade who was there.

Ryunard muttered with a frown.

"Karlton-nim is only picky about me."

"No. According to Article 1, Section 8 of the Transcendent Alliance Residence Law..."

His name, Karlton Xavier, who was reciting laws one after another, was called 'Silver Binding' because of the unique silver aura that shone from his entire body whenever he fought.

"You're reading a good story."

The old man spoke to me instead of the two who were chatting away.

The commander of the Transcendent Alliance.

Chunghuh, the God of Despair.

The old man who was known to be stronger than anyone else in this 'Transcendent Alliance'.

At first, I didn't know, but now I'm starting to realize it. Just standing next to him makes me feel sick.

This old man is definitely strong. He's strong enough to compete with even the Mythical-grade Constellations.

"Kyrgios is a great Captain. If you refer to his videos, you'll definitely learn a lot."

"Actually, it's a little strange. The Captain Kyrgios I knew wasn't that big."

"Oh, there's a story behind that."

"What's the story?"

Chunghuh stared at me in response to my question. It was as if my inner thoughts were written in his eyes.

"I can tell you, but is that really why you came here?"

He really isn't an ordinary old man.

I shook my head with a bitter smile.

"No. I have something to ask the Commander-in-Chief."

"I knew it."

Chunghuh was silent for a moment. I also remained silent for a moment and followed Chunghuh's gaze. We looked up at the Time Fault that had piled up for a moment.

"Is the world inside that Fault perhaps a different 'Worldline'?"

"It may have been so at one time, but it's not anymore. Now, it's literally a 'Fault.' It's a cross-section of events that have already passed."

Chunghuh added, as if he knew what I was worried about.

"That means that even if we change something inside, actual history won't change. Well, there are special Fault lines sometimes."

"It's like a novel that's already finished."

"Similar."

What did the Second Kim Dokja want to find in this world of countless completions?

Maybe he wasn't looking for something, but just couldn't accept that this world was finished.

So maybe he was holding on to events that had already ended and continuing to cause earthquakes.

"I also know a novel that's already finished."

With that thought in mind, I slowly opened my mouth.

"The novel begins with a giant tower appearing in the sky. People climb the tower to survive. They don't even realize that they're being redistributed as commodities while climbing the tower."

The moment I started talking, the surroundings became quiet.

I continued speaking in a quiet voice.

"The protagonist of that novel is a man who has been stabbing for a very long time. He's a man who has stabbed more than anyone else in the world and has become stabbing itself."

Does silence have color? The moment the word 「Stabbing」 came out, I felt as if the silence of the three people had changed to the same color at the same time.

When that color had spread enough, Ryunard asked.

"Newbie, do you know who we are?"

I nodded.

As he said, in fact, I already knew who Ryunard was.

The same was true of Karlton standing there and Chunghuh who was looking at me right in front of me.

Even so, the reason I didn’t recognize them from the beginning was probably because I was afraid of something. But now I had to accept it.

"You guys are."

These were the characters in 「The World After The Fall」 written by Kiyeon and me—

"People from a world that has already been destroyed."

Before coming here, they were the colleagues of 'Jaehwan-nim' whom I had met.

[NOTE 1]

OK

[NOTE 2]

[NOTE 3]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Image of the character Chunghuh - God of Despair from The World After the Fall (It is another work of the author Sing N Song, which they introduced in ORV)

Note [2]: Image of the character Ryunard - Naked Saint from The World After the Fall (It is another work of the author Sing N Song, which they introduced in ORV)

Note [3]: Image of the character Karlton - Silver Binding from The World After the Fall (It is another work of the author Sing N Song, which they introduced in ORV)

# 831 Episode 42 Destination (7)

People from the ruined world.

At my words, Karlton let out a light sigh and leaned against the wall, while Ryunard sat on a chair under the stone wall as if he was watching with interest.

They seemed to agree with my expression, sad, and somehow amused.

And on the other hand, they seemed to have transcended all those emotions.

Transcendents.

The <Star Stream> granted them that title because they had overcome all the limitations of mortals, including emotions.

However, in the worldview they belonged to— 《Tree of Imaginary》, they were called by different names.

Awakened.

Those who broke the limits of mortality and overcame the system. Those who live only in the time they set and understand the world with their own unique worldview.

A kind of god.

"It's been a long time since I've met someone who remembers the 《Tree of Imaginary》."

Do gods who have overcome emotions still have longing? As he spoke, a faint trace of emotion flashed through Chunghuh's eyes.

"How do you know about that world?"

"It's hard for me to explain in detail. I have some circumstances."

"I see. If you know our true identities, then there's no need to explain ourselves."

The three of them exchanged glances, their expressions relaxed for once.

"Hey, I feel good! Ask me anything you want! I'll answer everything!"

"What called you here?"

"Um, I don't know that either."

"You said you'd answer anything."

"How can you answer something you don't know?"

Chunghuh smiled and answered instead of Ryunard, who bluntly stuck out his lips.

"When all three of us woke up, we were here. It was as if someone had called us, just like you said."

Chunghuh's voice sounded somewhat floating, as if it still wasn't quite real.

"Did you create the Transcendent Alliance?"

"That's right."

"You mass-produced Transcendents?"

"Well, what can we do while we're stuck here? We have special restrictions, so we can't go outside the End Zone."

"How long have you been here?"

The three of them didn't say anything. That must mean it's been a long time.

"It was really boring at first. I took turns doing night watch with Karlton ajussi and Chunghuh-nim, fighting those strange gods, and becoming friends..."

"Then one day, people showed up."

"The first one to come was Yoo Hosung. Next was Kyrgios, and then Minyoung and Jungyeong came in."

They were probably the only ones who could so casually call the Invincible One and the Paradoxical Baekcheong, the First Sword of Goryeo, and the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

Chunghuh let out a hollow laugh for a moment, maybe having a special bond with the Captains.

"I didn't know I'd be teaching stabbing here too."

As I listened to that story, something connected in my head.

Come to think of it, when Kyrgios first taught Kim Dokja, he also taught him 'stabbing'.

"It was a little less boring back then, wasn't it?"

"Yes. There's also the reward of seeing the talented people grow."

"The Captains in particular are really no ordinary people. Even Captain Kyrgios is already stronger than me, right? You, a rookie, don't know how great that is, but..."

Chunghuh whispered in a small voice, watching Ryunard talking nonsense.

"Ryunard is excited for the first time in a while."

"..."

"Understand. He's happy that you came."

"He's happy that I came?"

"You're special just by existing. You came all the way up to the 'End of the Fear Realm' on your own, you read all the prophecies as soon as you came, and you know about us. You're already a huge incident here."

An incident.

"Why? Do you think we are acting too much like the Constellations?"

"No."

"We have no choice but to live in the present. We need events. Events that occur in the Time Fault or events that occur here. Otherwise, we can't stand it."

"There are questions that come up every time we are silent. Maybe my desire is not over yet. 'Why, I, we exist here now?'"

"..."

"Those simple and old questions drive us crazy."

I thought that maybe it was natural for them to become 'managers of the Time Fault'.

"Have you found the answer to your question?"

"Maybe. But I'm afraid to tell you the answer now.

I felt like I vaguely knew what the 'answer' Chunghuh was thinking.

Instead of guessing the answer, I said this.

"I have similar questions."

"Oh, really?"

I was just writing, and was dragged in, and suddenly became a villain character and lived here.

It's incredible when I think about it, but what can I do? It actually happened. Even now, I often ask myself. Why was it me? Because I am one of Kim Dokja’s reincarnations?

Then why did I possess 'Cheon Inho'?

「I want to know the end of this world more than anyone else, but maybe I am afraid of knowing the secrets of this world.」

Maybe Chunghuh and I are a little similar.

Chunghuh vaguely understood that fact and said,

"You are the type who asks questions 'despite all that'. Isn’t that right?"

"If I had to be specific, it would be that type of person."

"At this point, I think it wasn't a coincidence that you read the 'Prophecy of the End' all the way through."

"Oh, I apologize for that part."

"No. You don't have to feel sorry for us or the other Transcendents for that. If there is a beginning to anything, there must be an end. All the Transcendents here understand that fact well through the Time Fault lines. If the 'End Zone' ends here, then this is also the same story. Rather, everyone is interested."

Listening to Chunghuh's words, I gradually came to understand why the Transcendents were so indifferent to the End.

They must have already experienced the destruction of worlds big and small through the Time Fault.

That's why they are no longer shaken or saddened by the destruction right before their eyes.

"Is there no way to avoid the End?"

"No. The 'End-level Fear' is not something that can be avoided. For example, when the 'End-level Fear' opened last time—"

"About half of the Transcendents were torn apart. The alliance almost collapsed once."

Karlton took out a book from his bosom and answered. He flipped through the pages of the book a few times and added briefly.

"Before that, when the 'End-level Fear' opened, a third of the entire Time Fault went wild."

"Oh, I remember that too. The Commander-in-Chief personally stepped in and stopped it."

"The reason it ended like that back then was because there was a 'deal'…"

Deal?

Chunghuh smiled bitterly as he received my gaze.

"There is no way to avoid the End, but it is not that there is no way to respond. There is a way to minimize the damage."

"What is that?"

"Dealing with the Recorders."

"Speaking of the Recorders..."

"Have you heard of them? About the 'Recorders of Fear'."

I paused.

Is this story finally coming up?

"In the 'lines' of this Time Fault, there is a place where the Recorders reside. However, not just anyone can meet them, and only those who possess a special 'interpretation' of Fear or are qualified can have a private conversation with them."

"Do they have the power to stop the End?"

"Even they cannot completely stop the End. However... "

Chunghuh seemed very cautious about what he said next.

"They can 'Rewrite' this world."

In an instant, goosebumps ran through my entire body.

I hurriedly asked back.

"Can I meet them too?"

"Unfortunately, it's impossible for you. If you had come in a few months earlier, it would have been different..."

"Master, there's a way."

Ryunard, who had been watching the conversation with a smirk, said.

"Newbie. If you first resolve the Natural Disaster level or higher level Fear that appeared in the Time Fault, you will have one chance to face them."

"Ryunard, Natural Disaster level is not a level of Fear that the current rookie can resolve."

"I know. But let's tell the truth."

Natural Disaster level Fear.

That was the level given to the 'Dream Eater' I encountered when I entered here.

"The current rookie will have a hard time. If he trains here for at least a hundred years, I don't know."

Karlton was right.

As of now, no matter what I do, there is no way to solve the 'Natural Disaster level Fear' on my own.

I guess there is no other way. If this is the case, I think it would be better to use a desperate measure to get their help—

"Chief Commander! There's something wrong with the Time Fault!"

A Transcendent that was inspecting the Fault from the edge came running out of breath.

"There's something wrong with the Fault that the Captain of the Third Division entered."

Then, a hologram screen appeared before my eyes. Upon closer inspection, it was the very same Time Fault that Cheok Junkyeong and the Tired Division had entered before.

They had gone in to hunt the 'Dragon Eater', a terrifying disaster.

But as far as I know, Cheok Junkyeong had already dealt with that Outer God...

—Kuaaaah!

A bloody wind blew through the screen, and I saw the heads of two members of the Tired Division flying away.

The swords that lightly sliced off the heads of the Transcendents and were wandering through the air.

They were swords I knew.

"Excalibur?"

Among them, I saw Arthur's holy relic. However, the one holding that holy relic wasn't King Arthur.

"That guy."

Wings spread across the sky. A body with a skeletal appearance, decorated with molds from various cultures. The moment I saw the white shining crown of the guy, I realized who he was.

"The Founder of the Absolute Throne."

It seemed that he was already a famous Outer God here, so the Transcendents who had gathered in the Fault line hurriedly exchanged opinions.

"An Outer God of the level of a Natural Disaster. Among them, he is the top tier."

"Damn, I didn't see that guy for a while so I thought he disappeared—"

On the screen, Cheok Junkyeong was seen swinging his sword like a madman and fighting against the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

—Kuhahahaha! It's fun! It's fun!

Just watching it made my whole body shiver. The first sword of Goryeo, who didn't back down even in front of Outer Gods, was swinging his sword fiercely and going berserk. It felt like the unbelievable clash was being transmitted all the way here.

"The Captain of the Third Division can't fight him alone."

But an Outer God is an Outer God.

Even Cheok Junkyeong was slowly getting more and more wounds on his incarnation body. If things continued like this, it was obvious how the match would end.

I asked Chunghuh.

"Who are the Captains who can go?"

"The Captain of the Zeroth Division hasn't come out of the Fault yet. The First Division has just been dispatched. There are no Captains available right now."

The faces of the Transcendents were dark.

In the end, it was Karlton, the deputy Captain of the Zeroth division, who stepped forward.

"Me and Ryunard will go in."

"No. You have to guard this place."

"But if we leave it like that, the Captain of the Third Division—"

"You don't even have 'appropriate clothes' for that worldview, do you?"

Appropriate clothes.

Suddenly, Cheok Junkyeong's explanation came to mind.

I think he said that the Time Fault is a kind of possession, and that you can't use your 'incarnation' inside the Fault except in special cases.

"Even if you go in, you can't stop him in your current state."

In the end, Chunghuh, who had been worrying, made a decision.

"We can't lose the Captain of the Third Division here. This time, I'll do it myself—"

"I'll do it."

In an instant, the eyes of the Transcendents were focused on one place.

"I have an incarnation that fits the 'Time Fault'."

It was me.

[There is an 'incarnation' that fits you in that Time Fault.]

I don't know which Time Fault it is, but it seemed that Cheon Inho was still alive in that Time Fault.

Runyard shook his head and tried to dissuade me.

"Newbie, no matter what, I can't let you go. Even if there is a suitable incarnation, the level of Fear that you can enter and block is..."

"I can block it."

Even now, when I close my eyes, the scene comes to mind vividly.

The events of that day that I can't forget even if I die.

I felt the story inside me stir and opened my mouth.

"I killed that guy once."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 832 Episode 43 Transcendent Alliance (1)

Cheok Jungyeong thought about the word death for the first time in a while.

He couldn't even remember when he last thought of death. Was it when he was repeatedly beating the heavenly beings right before becoming a Constellation, or when he was being chased by [Fate] that was unleashed after fighting the giant nebulae after becoming a Constellation?

He couldn't help but snicker.

Perhaps the reason he was having such unnecessary thoughts was because his history was once again in crisis.

[You've become stronger than before. You damned bastard.]

Cheok Jungyeong said as he watched the Outer God walking slowly from afar.

The Founder of the Absolute Throne.

Some call him a 'Natural Disaster-level Fear'. Unlike other Outer Gods who were at the level of Natural Disasters, he had extremely high intelligence and the habit of moving like a human.

[What kind of stories have you stolen again?]

Despite Cheok Jungyeong's provocation, the Founder of the Absolute Throne did not respond and only rattled his skeleton. Cheok Jungyeong, who knew that it was the guy's laughter, simply bit his lips and swung his sword.

However, his body was swept away by the wind the Founder swung and was instantly thrown to the edge of the Fault.

Inside the Fear Realm, the Outer Gods regain their original power.

[The story, 'Greed of the Immortal King', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Longing of the Fear Monarch', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Mystery of the Old Being', begins its storytelling.]

…

The tales of the ancient times that the Constellations had ignored were shining brightly in the body of the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

This was a 'Natural Disaster level Fear' that could destroy a world.

However, Cheok Jungyeong was not foolishly taken advantage of either.

[The story, 'One Who Cuts the Sea', begins its storytelling.]

In the Fear Realm, the Transcendents were also able to exert power beyond their capabilities.

[The story, 'Manbyungguijang', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Dream Enemy', begins its storytelling.]

Stories, and Fears accumulated while clearing various Time Faults.

The Fears they fought against were their weapons themselves.

[Disaster-level Fear, 'Sword of the Dragon's Fang', begins its storytelling.]

Fear equipment tailored to Cheok Jungyeong.

As the long blade that grew in an instant took its place in Cheok Jungyeong's right hand, a black armor immediately enveloped Cheok Jungyeong's entire body.

[Disaster-level Fear, 'Crow Armor', activates!]

This was the full power posture of Cheok Jungyeong, the Third Captain of the Fear Realm, the First Swordsman of Goryeo.

He fought like a berserker. He didn't collapse even after being struck by dozens of arrows all over his body, after being struck by the flying sword.

He swung his sword once, then twice, and then thrice again.

A sword that could cut down a thousand people, destroy mountains, and cut down the sea.

But even with that sword, he couldn't cut down the Outer God in front of him.

[It's been a long time since I haven't been able to kill someone even with the three swords.]

With a gurgling sound, a teardrop flowed from the corner of Cheok Jungyeong's mouth. The incarnation body, which had reached its limit, shook precariously. The broken 'Crow Armor' scattered into ashes, and the Dragon Sword, which had lost its light, was stuck in the ground.

Cheok Jungyeong slowly felt the end approaching.

Push it.

The last thing that came to mind was his disciple's pale face.

Still, he thought it was fortunate. Even if he were to disappear here, his swordsmanship wouldn't disappear.

As his consciousness faded, Cheok Jungyeong continued to recall his disciple's face in his mind. At that moment when his vision was about to completely blur, a voice that seemed to pull out Cheok Jungyeong's soul was heard.

"Master, are you okay?"

Cheok Jungyeong looked back with a blank expression.

[This, this crazy—]

"I'm here."

[This damn disciple!]

Cheok Jungyeong hurriedly looked around. There were no surviving members of the Third Division nearby.

He instinctively blocked his disciple’s path.

[Escape quickly! I’ll buy you time!]

"Then, Master will die."

[I’m a Constellation! I won’t disappear just because my incarnation body disappears!]

"But you’ll take a blow that’s close to death."

His disciple was right.

Just because you’re a Constellation doesn’t mean you’re invincible. Especially if the essence of the story is damaged in the process of losing your incarnation body, you could easily be annihilated.

[Are you alone? What about the other captains?]

Cheok Jungyeong asked out of curiosity. If someone like Kyrgios, Yoo Hosung, or even someone like Ryunard had come in, the situation would have been a little better.

"I'm alone."

[What the hell!]

"Don't worry. I'll take care of everything."

[What can you do!]

Even Cheok Jungyeong knows that his disciple is strong. At that age, he's talented enough to use even the second sword of the three swords.

However, his opponent was none other than the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'. No matter how talented he was, in front of that 'Natural Disaster Fear'—

【Ooooooooo?】

The atmosphere of the battlefield changed in an instant. The 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' who had been approaching with a terrifying momentum suddenly stood still.

He could feel the emotions of the Outer God through the eerie wind.

Confusion. And… Fear.

Fearful? That Outer God is afraid? Of who on earth?

Cheok Jungyeong slowly turned his head following the Outer God's gaze. There stood his disciple who was emitting bright light from his entire body.

[What... what is that, disciple?]

"It's not that great. It's just that I have a story that he would hate."

A story?

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', chuckles.]

At first glance, it was a Quish Myth-level story. However, in a sense, it was 'just a story'. How could a 'Natural Disaster' Outer God stop because of a story?

"Master. If there's a way to defeat him, will you help me?"

He didn't know what the situation was, but it seemed certain that the clever disciple had a plan.

[Of course. Is there really a way?]

For a moment, Cheok Jungyeong felt a strange feeling. It felt like he had experienced a similar situation, but different.

"Yes. Then."

The disciple smiled brightly and pointed to his stomach.

"First, would you knock me out?"

---

The moment I entered the Time Fault, I realized that I was screwed.

"Wow."

It was good that I entered confidently. It wasn't bad that I declared that I would deal with that guy.

However, the moment I saw the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' filling the sky, the goosebumps on my spine didn't go away.

【Oh oh oh oh oh oh oh】

It was on a whole other level than when I saw it near the 'Void Curtain' sometime ago. It looked dozens of times bigger than then.

That was the true form of the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

I knew it instinctively. No matter who I followed with [Bookmark] or [Incite], it was impossible for me to deal with that guy with my current incarnation body.

So there was only one thing I could trust.

「Staging.」

In this <Star Stream>, 'history' is powerful enough to surpass the power of probability.

And I had the experience of defeating that guy once. But could I kill him with just this 'stage'?

Honestly, I wasn't confident. Above all, my incarnation body was so weak that it couldn't even handle Cheok Jungyeong's 'Three Swords'.

However, there was a way to overcome that.

"Heir-ah."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', asks if you really called him.]

"Help me."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', grumbles as if it's annoying.]

"Oh, don't you want to see the Second one?"

Ultimately, this 'Heir of the Eternal Name' guy's goal is to create the 'One and Only Kim Dokja'.

He must also understand that he has no choice but to listen to me in order to do that.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', grumbles and begins its storytelling.]

And he must know very well what skill I need right now.

"Master! Now!"

The next moment, Cheok Jungyeong's sword hit my abdomen.

With a scream, the world spun around and I lost consciousness.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', is activated.]

It's not the [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] that I used, but the [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] that the 'Demon King of Salvation' used.

As I felt the skill being activated, the 'Demon King of Salvation's' characteristic elation filled my whole body.

I can do it.

It's a method I've never tried in the main story, but it might be possible now.

[Your understanding of the Constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' is high.]

Because.

[The target has a deep favor toward you.]

My understanding of 'Goryeo's First Sword, Cheok Jungyeong' is higher now than ever before in the main story.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', stage 3 is activated!]

'I'll borrow your incarnation body for a moment, Master.'

A full energy permeated my whole body.

When I opened my eyes again, I was in a state of empathy with Cheok Jungyeong's incarnation body. The 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' who saw my appearance from afar let out a threatening cry.

【Oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh】

Just hearing it a little while ago was a chilling roar, but now it was somehow acceptable.

Because I am now the best warrior in Goryeo.

The strongest incarnation.

I was able to be sure only after I had entered. At least, there is no being stronger than Cheok Jungyeong in a human body right now.

However, even with this astonishing incarnation body, it was difficult to deal with that Outer God. But,

"It's different on this 'stage'."

The story took root on top of 'Unbreakable Faith', and an unprecedentedly bright 'Blade of Faith' colored the surroundings.

['Staging' begins!]

Is it because the story has evolved over time?

The scenery that unfolded before my eyes was not the scene of Gwanghwamun where Kim Dokja destroyed the absolute throne.

A scene of a pitch-black curtain billowing overhead. This was—

【Ga ah ah ah ah ah ah】

Where I lost Han Sooyoung.

「How much stronger have I become since then?」

The image of Han Sooyoung collapsing in my arms was still vivid.

Old resentment welled up.

Memories of surviving under the rippling curtain of emptiness with her help swirled through my head.

「"I'm sorry I couldn't tell you the story you wanted."」

Where is Han Sooyoung, who said that, now?

I wonder if she's still watching this story somewhere in this universe.

She must be. She must be watching.

「This was proof of the oath I made that day.」

The sword power that had grown explosively cut down the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'. The astonished guy screamed. At the same time, the giant blade he swung slashed at my entire body, aiming for it. Every time I blocked the blade, I felt a shock as if my bones were crushed.

Even so, I didn't stop. Attacks that took each other's flesh and bones.

I recalled the days I lived desperately, swinging my sword again and again.

The countless nights I studied the stories.

The hours I read the 'Ways of Survival'.

The days I tried to show Han Sooyoung 'my story' that I had promised.

【Oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh】

Han Sooyoung, I'm sorry.

Maybe I hadn't grown much at that point. I'm still ridiculously weak to show my story.

But still.

At least now, I—

「I've become a little more like Kim Dokja.」

「King of a Kingless World was written on the tip of the sword that cut briskly.」

The 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' who was fatally wounded by the stories that suddenly popped out let out a gasp of shock.

"Do you feel it now? That it's different from back then?"

I knew who my smiling expression resembled, and who my speech resembled.

I used to be afraid of becoming a Kim Dokja. Now I am not.

Because I know that becoming a Kim Dokja or becoming like Kim Dokja does not mean losing myself.

Thinking like Kim Dokja does not mean that the 'Lee Hakhyun' inside me disappears.

After all, all people end up becoming like someone.

"You may not know, but I have had many experiences."

I thought of the people who were imbued with the name of Kim Dokja. Among those names were Gu Seonah and Kim Kyungsik, who risked their lives for their colleagues. There was Jung Jaewoo, who was luckier than anyone else, there was Go Jangwon, who gave his life for Jung Heewon's younger sibling, and there was No Jiyoon, who missed her father until the very end.

Therefore, the fact that I am now a Kim Dokja.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', shines brightly.]

It means that I can remember more people.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 833 Episode 43 Transcendent Alliance (2)

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With the addition of stage buffs to Cheok Jungyeong's incarnation, the fight gradually became more even. And the fact that this confrontation was even seemed to be a huge shock to the Outer God.

【Ooooooooooo】

For a moment, a mere Constellation possessed the same power as the Outer God. Perhaps that alone was enough to bewilder the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' who had reigned in the void for thousands of years.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', laughs at the Outer God.]

Even the guy felt something unusual in my story, and he even backed away, his huge body trembling.

【King of the ■ of the ■…?】

But in the end, both he and I knew. There was no place to retreat in this fight. The one who runs away will definitely die. The moment he let out his final roar, we clashed once again. His sword cut my flesh, and my sword tore his bones.

In the midst of that flurry of sword strikes where flesh and bones were scattered, I was Cheok Jungyeong, and I was the Swordsman of Goryeo.

The next moment, the movement of the Outer God became strange. An unusual energy was gathering from his entire body.

I also realized instinctively. The next strike would determine the end of this fight.

【Wooooooooooooo】

Watching the guy's swirling energy, I also prepared my final technique.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv. 10', activates!]

The strongest technique that Cheok Jungyeong can use with his body.

It wasn't originally a technique that Cheok Jungyeong was allowed to use— but if it's just a little bit, it might be possible to imitate it.

"I—"

My right arm, filled with strength, swelled as if it would burst. The pages of the main story flipped over in my head.

The strongest Cheok Jungyeong I know. I think of the way Cheok Jungyeong holds his sword, the way he looks at the world.

And I recall his worst enemy at the end of his gaze.

"The one who cut the Indescribable Distance—"

An enemy that was much scarier, stronger, and more terrifying than the being in front of me now.

"It's Cheok Jungyeong!"

Finally, Cheok Jungyeong created a technique to cut it.

His four-sword method.

Four-swords swordsmanship.

Was my skill lacking? Along with the feeling of my grip being torn, an incredible sense covered my entire body. The sensation of all the legends contained in my incarnation body being squeezed out.

I drew my sword with a scream. The space before my eyes tore and my vision turned white.

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint 'Stage 3' is forcibly terminated!]

The soul that had been in the incarnation body of Cheok Jungyeong was unable to overcome the shock and bounced off.

When I returned to my incarnation body, it felt like someone had hit my head with a hammer. I felt dizzy and had difficulty breathing. For some reason, my legs wouldn't move. I tried to raise my upper body, but everything below my knees had disappeared.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is activated!]

Did I get caught in the aftershock?

It was quite a clash. It was a clash between Cheok Jungyeong's strongest secret technique and the Outer God.

I saw Cheok Jungyeong's incarnation collapse in the grayish dust. It seemed to have taken a huge blow.

I wonder what happened to the Outer God.

【Ka Ka Ka Ka Ka】

An eerie laughter could be heard from somewhere. The shadow of the Outer God staggering in the dust storm was visible. It seemed like the last blow was not enough. Even so, the guy must have taken a fatal blow, because his height had decreased drastically. The guy's gigantic body that had filled the sky was now the size of an adult male.

【In your story】

Since the 'stage transformation' hadn't ended yet, there was still a chance.

However, the guy seemed to know that.

【You can't kill me】

Maybe that clever Outer God had anticipated this moment. That's why he had already destroyed the legs of my returning incarnation body.

【Just like back then】

Just ten steps. I could have just walked ten steps and stabbed the guy in the heart with my sword, but I didn't have the strength left to do that.

['Staging' ends.]

Even the stage transformation, which was my last hope, had disappeared.

I watched the guy approaching me step by step, thinking and thinking in my head.

It was strange.

Even in a life-threatening situation, I strangely didn't feel nervous.

That might be.

—Youngest. It could be because there is a Kim Dokja inside you.

"Yes."

It could be because I have become like Kim Dokja to that extent.

—Let's use that.

I nodded and looked around.

「This 'Time Fault' is a page of the 'Ways of Survival' that I know.」

The ruined landscape of Seoul. Collapsed buildings. A place where 'civilization' once existed.

Finally, I had a 'Fear' that I could use in such an environment.

[Story fragment, 'Remote Signal Controller', begins its storytelling.]

[Disaster-level Fear, 'Alien Traffic Light', reinterpreted.]

For a moment, the guy who was approaching across the road stopped. He must have instinctively realized that something was wrong.

"Did you notice?"

The moment the guy standing on the four-lane road looked around in confusion, I smiled and said.

"Don't jaywalk, you idiot."

[Disaster-level Fear, 'Alien Traffic Light', is activated!]

Along with the red signal light shining from afar, something invisible came running and hit the guy's whole body.

The original guy wouldn't have flinched at this level of shock, but it was different now. The guy's body, hit by the Four Swords, was already like rags.

A terrible scream and a loud noise erupted in front of my eyes. I saw the broken stories leaving long skid marks on the floor.

The 'Founder of the Absolute Throne', who was being horribly broken in real time, reached out to me.

【Ah ah ah ah ah ah ah】

The cause of death on the Outer God was 'traffic accident'.

It was an absurd ending for an Outer God that had commanded the world.

[Natural Disaster Fear, 'Founder of the Absolute Throne', has been defeated!]

I saw the dead guy's stories scattering into the void.

The old stories were being released from him. I blankly looked up at the stories that rose to the sky like falling snow.

[All the Fears of the Fear Realm are surprised by your feat.]

Forgotten Fears, Fears that are being forgotten.

In the spaces between sentences, words that had turned into Fear and could not be read were shining as if dancing in the air.

This world is full of Fear Realms.

At that moment, I felt like I understood a little bit why the Second Kim Dokja was staying in this 'Fear Realm'.

[It takes time to suggest an interpretation and pay the reward.]

[The Time Fault resolution task has been completed!]

[A new 'story' has been acquired!]

My consciousness became blurred as the Fear landscape collapsed. It must be because I spilled too much blood.

[The Recorders of Fear are interested in your 'interpretation'.]

I heard the recorders' message through my blurred consciousness.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Fox Who Commands the Sky', is interested in your interpretation.]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Prince of Wolves', is interested in your interpretation.]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Demon King of the Cinema', is interested in your interpretation.]

…

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Architect Of The False Last Act', is interested in your interpretation.]

---

It was a week later when I opened my eyes again. How did I know that fact as soon as I opened my eyes?

[Time Remaining: 21 days and 2 hours]

The countdown in the air told me.

The moment I saw the numbers that appeared, my mind was filled with mixed emotions.

The thought that there were only 21 days left until the end. And.

「The Founder of the Absolute Throne has been defeated.」

When I lifted the blanket, the two legs that had been cut off were reattached. Was this also the power of the 'Fear Realm'? Or was it treated with another special Fear? I don't know. Seeing that both legs were still intact, I couldn't be more certain.

Did I really kill the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'?

Of all people, that terrifying 'Outer God'?

[A new story has been acquired.]

As expected, the message blinking in the air proved that what I had done was real.

Even though I had borrowed the incarnation of Cheok Jungyeong and used the trick of 'staging', I had definitely killed the Outer God.

And this was a sweet reward for my courage.

With trembling hands, I reached out to the story message.

Even though the Constellations weren't watching, the story's fame would decline, but I would still have gained an incredible story.

But.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', ate the new tale.]

I checked the message again and again, thinking I had seen something wrong.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', lightly burps.]

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', asks what you're looking at.]

What the hell?

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', declares that he's going to take a nap because he's sleepy.]

I couldn't believe it. This damn bastard just ate the new story I just got?

"You bastard! Throw it up! Throw it up!"

But the story didn't respond at all.

Come to think of it, I had forgotten to feed him for quite some time. I hadn't gotten any new Kim Dokja fragments in a while, and I hadn't gotten any stories to give him.

I thought that maybe I had borrowed a lot of strength this time, so he had gotten a story in return.

And of course, not getting a new story wasn't necessarily a loss. After all, 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is also my story.

In short, it meant that I hadn't gotten a new story, but my existing story had gotten even stronger.

I could tell the moment I slowly got up from my seat and looked at the mirror in the ward. The rank has risen.

If before, I was barely able to compete with the 'Historical-grade Constellations', the rank flowing out of my entire body was clearly approaching Narrative-grade.

Now, I could properly use the power of the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Since I had not yet obtained a powerful incarnation body, it would be difficult to abuse the power of a Narrative-grade Constellation, but the fact that I had reached the full rank made me strangely excited.

That was when the door to the hospital room opened.

[It seems that you had an epiphany.]

"Master."

It was Cheok Jungyeong and Anna Croft.

---

I listened to Anna Croft for a full 10 minutes about what had happened. To summarize, the content itself was simple.

The Transcendents of the Transcendent Alliance who had seen my fight were greatly shocked.

Some of the lower-ranking Transcendents were even shocked by my fight and jumped back into the 'Time Fault' to train.

"It's not something that can be summarized so simply. Do you know how surprised everyone was?"

"Ah, that's enough. I didn't do it alone."

It was a strategy I wouldn't have been able to try if Cheok Jungyeong hadn't been there in the first place.

I glanced at Cheok Jungyeong. He probably had a lot of questions.

What was the 'Four-Swords' technique I used? How was I able to empathize with his incarnation?

But he didn't ask anything. I couldn't tell if it was his original personality or consideration, but either way, it was a happy thing for me.

[Ahem, you guys. Have you heard about my disciple's achievements?]

Cheok Jungyeong, who had been harassing the people in the next ward for a while, turned to me when the Transcendents, tired of him bragging about his disciple, slowly backed away.

[Are you going to meet the Recorders?]

Is it finally time?

[The Recorders are very interested in the 'Fear' you interpreted this time. You might be able to get a better reward than expected. Since you're the first to kill that crazy guy.]

"Reward. They're giving me something?"

[What? You entered the fault without knowing anything?]

My goal was simply to meet the 'Recorders of Fear', not to extract anything from them.

But from what I heard, it seems that 'interpretations' of Fear are treated quite preciously in this Fear Realm.

[Transcendents who obtain unique interpretations can enter the 'Hidden Time Fault' by trading with the Recorders.]

Hidden Time Fault.

[It's difficult to raise the Transcendental level even by one level in a normal Time Fault, and it takes a long time to train. However, the 'Time Fault' they have is a little different. There are Faults that can skip several levels of Transcendence, and there are faults that can drastically reduce the time it takes to jump to a higher level. Not only that, depending on the Fault you choose—]

Cheok Jungyeong looked at me with a worried expression for a moment, then continued.

[You could become a Demon King, an Angel, or even an Outer God.]

That's possible just by experiencing a Special Time Fault?

I was surprised, but I didn't show it on the outside. It didn't.

Power gained quickly always comes with a price. Even if it was the 'Recorder of Fear's' Time Fault, there was no guarantee that it would be an exception to that rule.

We soon followed Cheok Jungyeong to the Recorder's room.

"Why are you following me, Kim Anna-ssi?"

"I also decided to see the Recorders this time."

"You've also solved a Natural Disaster-level Fear?"

Honestly, I was surprised. I had high hopes for Anna Croft, but she had already interpreted a 'Natural Disaster-level Fear'?

Anna Croft answered with a somewhat dispirited expression.

"Not as much as you, but I have my own unique interpretation of Fear."

It seemed that Anna Croft had solved quite a few Fears during the week that I had passed out. Among them, there was one interpretation that was 'Disaster-level' enough to catch the attention of the Recorders, even if it wasn't a 'Natural Disaster-level' one.

"Kim Anna-ssi."

"Yes?"

"I think you've done well at work."

"What does that mean?"

"You must have spoken Spanish well, too."

"Is it that weird joke from last time again?"

As I walked through the ward, I felt the nearby Transcendents whispering to me. It's been so long since I joined the Transcendent Alliance that I feel burdened by this kind of gaze.

I hid behind Kim Anna and followed after Cheok Jungyeong.

After a while, we arrived at a small door in the room of the Time Fault. On the black door, there were various hieroglyphs that reminded me of stars, moons, suns, birds, and wolves.

"Can I open this door?"

[Yes. Think of the Recorder you want to meet and open the door, and you can enter his residence.]

I recalled the messages I had heard just before I fainted.

Messages from the Recorders of Fear who wanted to meet me.

[Currently, a total of four 'Recorders of Fear' want to contact you.]

Cheok Jungyeong added a word, perhaps worried about me.

[Keep that in mind, disciple. There is only one Recorder you can deal with.]

There is only one Recorder I can meet.

I checked the list of 'Recorders of Fear' I could choose.

My choice was already decided.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 834 Episode 43 Transcendent Alliance (3)

"The 'Recorder of Fear I will choose is—"

Needless to say, the Recorder of Fear I will choose is the 'Architect of the False Last Act'.

There was no reason to hesitate.

The true name of that Recorder must be Han Sooyoung.

"The—"

But the moment I said that, a fierce spark flew before my eyes.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' in question does not exist on the list.]

"Huh?"

It was strange.

No, I saw it clearly.

Right after I killed the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne', I clearly received a message that the 'Architect of the False Last Act'' was interested in my interpretation.

I called out the same modifier once again.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' in question does not exist on the list.]

"I asked you to let me meet Han Sooyoung?"

This time, there was no response at all. The Transcendents nearby who were watching me were muttering, perhaps because they thought my appearance was strange.

"Was there a recorder with that name?"

"This is the first time I've heard of it."

What on earth could it be?

—Why is that?

Kim Dokja, who only appears when he has something to say, showed up again this time without fail.

"Didn't you see it just now?"

—What?

"Han Sooyoung was there, right?"

—What nonsense. Why is Han Sooyoung here?

"No, it's definitely the 'Architect of the False Last Act'..."

With those words, the call was disconnected again.

Did the call go through for a moment because of the spark? Anyway, this person is not helpful when it's really important.

By the way, if Kim Dokja didn't see the message, was it only me who saw it?

I called out her modifier one last time.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' in question does not exist in the list.]

[Reconfirming the list of 'Recorders of Fear' that are currently available.]

—The Fox Who Commands the Sky

—The Prince of Wolves

—The Demon King of the Cinema

—The Evil Sophist

There was none.

Even the 'Architect of the False Last Act' was shamelessly taken by the 'Evil Sophist'.

No, it's not like I took all the lemon candies away, so how can she disappear like this?

I wanted to protest right away, but I didn't know where to protest. Since even the system message was treated as 'Fear' in the first place, there was nothing to say if there was false information.

There was nothing I could do. Right now, I had to choose another 'Recorder of Fear' instead of Han Sooyoung.

I looked at the list carefully and again.

As I looked at it so carefully, I felt like I was back in the days of selecting a sponsor.

First, the 'Fox Who Commands the Sky'. If I'm right, this being is the Recorder of Fear I've already met.

The Recorder who approached me at the Recycling Center - Bicheonhori.

Considering that his nickname includes the word fox, and that this character was called 'Yoo Joonghyuk's trickster' in 'Ways of Survival', the first choice was definitely 'Bicheonhori Wang Weilong'.

That 'Bicheonhori' became a Recorder of Fear... What on earth is the criteria for becoming a Recorder of Fear?

Second, the Prince of Wolves.

The first thing that came to mind when I saw him was 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.

That's because I've seen Yoo Joonghyuk transform into a 'black beast' in the 41st Round.

Is that all? In the main story, Yoo Joonghyuk in the 1,863rd round was also likened to a 'wolf'.

There's no way Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round would suddenly become a Recorder of Fear... So, could the 'Prince of Wolves' be 'Secretive Plotter'? My heart raced for a moment, but when I thought about it carefully, it couldn't be true.

If you think about the fact that the most revered being of the 'Recorders of Fear' was the 'Secretive Plotter', the strongest Outer God, there was no way that the 'Secretive Plotter' himself could become a Recorder.

Then... this would most likely be Lycaon.

Lycaon had previously appeared with the nickname 'Lost Guide', but it was possible that he had risen in rank and acquired a new modifier after our exchange.

Third, the Demon King of the Cinema.

Honestly, the third one was the hardest to guess. 'Cinema' and 'Demon King'? It felt like two keywords that were far apart were forcibly linked together.

However, if you just look at the keywords themselves, there were a few characters that came to mind. At that time, there was only one character in this world line who satisfied both of those keywords at the same time.

Asmodeus, the Demon King of Lust and Wrath. If the guy who had the 'theater' where readers gathered was a 'Recorder of Fear', then the incomprehensible miracles he had committed so far would be somewhat understandable.

Lastly, the 'Evil Sophist'.

What is this... It's probably that guy.

My worries were short.

If I can't meet Han Sooyoung, then I only have one choice anyway.

「Meeting Cheon Inho from the 40th Round.」

It would be meaningful to meet Bicheonhori and hear his story or meet Lycaon again, but the most valuable information source right now was the 'Evil Sophist'.

The Evil Sophist.

That was the nickname of the '40th Round Cheon Inho'.

I was curious. What kind of person was the 40th Round Cheon Inho that neither Yoo Joonghyuk nor Anna could properly remember?

Why did I possess Cheon Inho in the 41st Round?

The 'Evil Sophist' would definitely know that fact. The moment I opened the door with that thought.

[Your 'interpretation' has been recognized as having special value by the Recorders of Fear.]

[You have been given the opportunity to meet all four Recorders once.]

A huge plain unfolded before my eyes along with an unexpected message.

A pleasant breeze brushed the tip of my nose.

I somehow felt like I knew where this was.

【Student.】

When I turned around, a huge wolf was standing there.

"Lycaon!"

The Prince of the Planet Chronos.

The wolf of Immyuntar who sacrificed himself again for me.

[You entered the room of the Recorder of Fear 'Prince of Wolves'.]

【Student. Since we don't have time, I'll keep it brief.】

Before we could even exchange greetings, Lycaon's body was disappearing in the blowing wind.

"Lycaon?"

【Thank you, student. Thanks to the student's records, I received a new modifier. However, I have not yet recovered enough strength to make contact with student. The reason I came here is...】

Lycaon's voice, shouting quickly, dispersed in the wind in real time.

【Don't believe any records until you see them with your own eyes! All the 'Recorders' of the Fear Realm are eventually...!]】

The moment Lycaon spoke that far, someone's finger snapping was heard.

【What do you mean, it's useless for a Low-level Recorder to try to cut in?】

And then, as if by magic, Lycaon's room disappeared.

[The turn of the Recorder of Fear 'Prince of Wolves' has ended.]

What then appeared was a background with a martial arts theme.

[You have entered the room of the Recorder of Fear 'Fox Who Commands the Sky'.]

The voices of martial artists could be heard from outside. People eating a light meal of noodles in chicken soup.

The Fox Who Commands the Sky— Bicheonhori was in the center of such a peaceful landscape, like a still life painting.

【Sit down.】

To be honest, I was a little overwhelmed. The air of detachment I felt from him was strangely different from when I met the Constellations.

If I had to compare, I would say it was similar to the feeling I got when I faced Outer gods or Fear.

As I carefully sat down in the seat across from him, Bicheonhori quietly raised his hand and ordered the menu.

【Two bowls of noodles in chicken broth, please.】

The waiter who took his order immediately brought out steaming hot chicken broth and noodles.

A martial arts set out of nowhere.

To be honest, I didn’t know what was what, but I decided to try it anyway since it was given to me.

And the moment I took a bite, I realized.

「This is the 'real thing'.」

A taste that seemed to deny all the noodles I'd ever had.

It was a taste that even Yoo Joonghyuk would have to admit.

Bicheonhori asked, perhaps because my expression was funny.

【Is it delicious?】

"Yes, it's delicious."

【Thank goodness. It's my favorite restaurant. It's gone now.】

It seems that this 'space' was a kind of 'Time Fault' that Bicheonhori owned.

We watched the people passing by the guest house for a moment.

The sound of soft voices. The smell of ingredients being fried and steamed.

Even in the world of scenarios, there is still peace between the lines.

I didn't know which 'Round' this Fault was. However, I thought I knew what this place meant to Bicheonhori.

"Is this your 'Round'?"

Bicheonhori answered my question after a short pause.

【That's right. I saw the end of the world in this Round.】

The end of the world.

The weight of those words suddenly thrown out shook me.

"Does that mean… you cleared the 'Last Scenario'? Did you see the [Final Wall] by any chance?"

Bicheonhori just smiled vaguely at my words.

It probably meant that he couldn't answer. Or it could mean that the deal has already begun.

【That's a question that can only be answered through a deal. Would you like to start the deal?】

As expected.

【I'm interested in the 'Natural Disaster-level Fear' that you interpreted.】

Because he seemed a bit impatient, Bicheonhori quickly continued speaking.

【With your original status, you would never have been able to hunt the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'. Even if the 12 gods of <Olympus> came, it would be difficult to hunt him.】

"…"

【But you did it. I want the 'story' behind that achievement.】

What I defeated him with was the power of 「Staging」. Bicheonhori must be curious about the true nature of that story.

However, I didn't intend to give up the only card I had so easily.

"I don't plan on passing the interpretation yet. I haven't met the other 'Recorders' either."

【Hmm, I can give you what the other Recorders can't give you. Right now, it seems like you need to quickly achieve transcendence. Isn't that right?】

Bicheonhori continued speaking with a smile still on his face.

【As you probably know, your current incarnation body doesn't fit your rank. In your current state, it'll be difficult to properly use even 30% of your rank. However, if I help you, things might be different.】

I was sincere when I said I had no intention of handing over the interpretation to Bicheonhori right away.

That's because I only had one chance to deal with the 'Recorders of Fear'.

However, Bicheonhori's offer that followed was tempting even for me.

【I'll grant you the Time Fault of the <0th Murim>.】

<0th Murim>.

A place where all kinds of elixirs are abundant, comparable to the stigma of the Nebulae. Considering that you can obtain the treasures of ancient Murim with high difficulty of acquisition and even martial arts skills, it is one of the 'Time Faults' that can be selected at the present time.

It was considered the top tier.

If I could just use that place, I would be able to become a Transcendent, and I would also be able to completely unlock the power of a Narrative-grade Constellation.

【Do you need to think about it any more? I can give you whatever you want. Whether it's the path to becoming a Transcendent or an item.】

I was silent for a moment.

Becoming a Transcendent?

Of course it's important.

<The 0th Murim>?

It's truly a fascinating choice.

But there was one more important prerequisite for me than anything else.

The most important reason why I came to this place.

【I see. Now that I think about it, you were also a 'Kim Dokja', so how about this?】

But this clever fox seemed to have already figured out the reason.

【If you hand me that interpretation, I'll help you go to the 'Big House'.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Big house.

The fact that Bicheonhori used that word meant that he already knew that I had come here to meet the 'Second Kim Dokja'.

"I don't know if you remember, but I've met you before."

Bicheonhori looked at me with deep eyes as if he would listen to what I had to say.

"The first time was during the 'Twelve Zodiac Race' at the 'Recycling Center'."

【Hmm. That Bicheonhori you ran with wasn't me.】

"I think it was you who spoke last time, wasn't it?"

I still remembered his last words clearly.

「"Hmm. Is this how it's going to be this time... I hope we get another chance to meet, young man."」

Bicheonhori blinked as if he was somewhat surprised by my answer, then nodded.

【I didn't know you'd remember that time. You're right. That was definitely what I said.】

"We met again after that. On the 'Orient Express carriage' at the 'Recycling Center'."

At that time, I used [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] on Dansu ahjussi and encountered Bicheonhori, who was riding with him.

I also remember clearly what Bicheonhori said to me at that time.

He told me that I would not be able to become a 'Recorder' yet. He also said that I would not be able to write the next chapter of the world because there were too many voices holding me back.

【I have told too many useless things to a friend with a good memory.】

"How did you become a 'Recorder of Fear'? What on earth is the principle of a Recorder of Fear?"

I thought of Lycaon.

Bicheonhori said that he saw the 'end of the world', but as far as I know, Lycaon has never seen the 'end of the world'.

Even so, Lycaon and Bicheonhori both became 'Recorders of Fear'.

"What on earth is your purpose?"

Lycaon said.

'Their job is to collect records of the distorted world lines.'

But that job itself is probably not their goal. There must be some grand purpose behind their collecting records.

【You have a habit of asking too many questions at once.】

"Is this question also a subject of trade?"

【In principle, yes. So, if you pass the interpretation to me, if you pass that, you can ask as many questions as you want—】

"Can't I give you a 'different interpretation'?"

【Different interpretation?】

Bicheonhori, who had been tilting his head for a moment, suddenly threw his head back and started laughing heartily.

【That's an interesting question. There's no way you, who has only recently entered the Fear Realm, would have a 'Special Interpretation'?】

He was right. The other Fears I've interpreted — 'Alien Signal Light' and 'Tooth Fin' are Catastrophe-level or Disaster-level Fears. It would be difficult to attract the attention of the Recorder with Fears of that level. But.

"It's not like 'Fear' is only in the Fear Realm, right?"

【What are you trying to say?】

"I'm talking about the 'Oldest Fear' in this world."

The Oldest Fear in this world.

The origin of this universe that no one has been able to interpret, cannot interpret, and will not be interpreted.

Bicheonhori opened his mouth with a slightly hardened expression.

【Could it be that you're talking about the 'Oldest Dream' right now?】

A light spark flew, but it wasn't filtered. I don't know how powerful a 'Recorder of Fear' Bicheonhori is, but it seems that he can say that name without filtering.

I nodded and answered.

"Yes. I'll tell you about that guy's true identity."

【You're funny. Do you think there's a Recorder of Fear who doesn't know that?】

"His name is Kim Dokja."

【I know. That's the name of the 'symbol' that currently refers to dreams.】

He didn't seem surprised at all. If you're a Recorder of Fear, you know everything up to here.

Then how about this?

"Do you know what food Kim Dokja hates?"

Bicheonhori's expression hardened for the first time at my question.

【Why should I know that?】

"Why should you know? Are you saying that you're not curious about the Oldest Dream right now? Of all people, a 'Recorder of Fear'?"

【No, that's—】

"Are you saying that this interpretation that even the great Morak you revere doesn't know is unnecessary, useless, trivial, and not even worth recording?"

【I never said that! However—】

Bicheonhori hesitated with a very confused expression, then grabbed his pen as if he had decided on something.

【What food does Kim Dokja hate...?】

"Tomatoes."

Bicheonhori opened his eyes wide and began to write something in the air.

【Interesting. Why does he hate tomatoes?】

"From there, it's a trade target. Are you curious?"

It was quite amusing to see Bicheonhori’s dumbfounded expression.

He asked, his lips curled as if he had been hit.

【I see. What was it that you were curious about earlier?】

"How are the Recorders of Fear born?"

【I don’t know exactly how the Recorders of Fear are born. Each Recorder has a different reason.】

Different reasons?

【Some become Recorders after despairing at the end of the world and wanting to leave that despair behind, while others become Recorders to fulfill their unfulfilled wishes in another universe. And some—】

After pausing for a beat, Bicheonhori looked straight into my eyes and continued speaking.

【Some become Recorders after cursing the ending of a universe and wanting to write a new ending.】

"This explanation is too vague."

【But this is all I can say. After all, the 'Recorders' are those chosen by the 'Oldest Dream'.】

Those chosen by the Oldest Dream.

【Becoming a Recorder of Fear means that they hold the possibility of a record that the Oldest Dream can hope for.】

"Is that the answer? I don't even know what you're talking about, and it's not worth trading."

【Huh, you now—】

"So let me ask you one more question. What is your purpose? Why are you collecting interpretations from the Fear Realm and collecting records of the twisted world line?"

【Isn't that a question?】

"Anyway, aren't you going to write something vague and plausible? Tell me quickly."

Bicheonhori now looked as if he was dumbfounded. However, since he was curious about why Kim Dokja hates tomatoes, he had no choice but to answer.

【The reason we collect records of the twisted world line is to write a single 'sentence'.】

"More specifically."

【Do you know what the first thing you have to do to become a good writer is?】

"Well... I guess it's reading a lot, writing a lot, and thinking a lot."

What I said was the basic quality of a good writer.

Reading a lot. Writing a lot. Thinking a lot.

Bicheonhori nodded as if he agreed with those words.

【Before the end of this universe, all 'Recorders of Fear' will be able to write their 'One Sentence' that will remain forever.】

A sentence that will remain forever.

【All Recorders of Fear live their entire lives for that One Sentence from the moment of birth. They collect different interpretations for that sentence and gather records of distorted world lines.】

I suddenly thought that they resembled the Constellations.

Just as the Constellations build up stories and perform scenarios to complete their ■■, the Recorders also repeat the same thing to write the ultimate 'One Sentence'.

[NOTE 1]

"I guess the reason you want my interpretation is for the same reason."

【That's right. I thought I needed to refer to your interpretation to complete my 'One Sentence'.】

"What will happen to you if you can write that 'One Sentence'?"

【That is...】

Bicheonhori smiled brightly and continued.

【I will tell you after hearing your answer. Now, tell me. Why does Kim Dokja hate tomatoes?】

As expected, Yoo Joonghyuk's trickster.

He won't just tell me everything.

【Quickly. Why on earth does he hate tomatoes? Is it because tomatoes remind him of 'blood'?】

I hadn't thought of that.

Bicheonhori smiled and asked, perhaps seeing my expression.

【There must be another reason?】

"It's just because they don't taste good."

Bicheonhori made a blank expression.

【That can't be true.】

"It's true."

【Don't make me laugh. How do you know that? You didn't ask the 'Oldest Dream'.】

"I hate tomatoes too."

【What is that...】

"I'm Kim Dokja too. Did you forget?"

Bicheonhori opened his mouth as if he had been hit again.

I smiled at him and said,

"Then this is the end of the deal. I will see you again next time."

[The turn of the Recorder of Fear 'Fox that Commands the Sky' will soon end.]

As Bicheonhori's appearance slowly began to disperse along with the surrounding scenery, he shouted urgently.

【You can't avoid it with such wordplay forever! In order to go to the 'Big House' you want, you have to clear one of the Faults that our Recorder has...!】

"If there was such a condition, you should have told me about it a long time ago."

Unfortunately, Bicheonhori's body was almost gone.

He finished his words with a somewhat hurt expression.

【If possible, it would be better to deal with me. The next 'Recorder' will be a friend much more sinister than me. Think about it carefully...】

With those words, the scenery of Murim completely disappeared.

And when I opened my eyes again.

[Entering the room of the Recorder of Fear 'Demon King of the Cinema'.]

I was sitting in the cinema. A long horizontal line was drawn on the screen that was cast through the darkness. It looked like someone had torn something up and put it together.

A group of small heads were watching the screen.

Since I knew where this was, I didn't panic and watched the screen with the kkoma Kim Dokjas.

「"Cheon Inho, that bad guy."」

The movie shown on the screen was a story I already knew.

The story began when a piece of the stupid Kim Dokja possessed 'Cheon Inho' among the many characters.

【Why did it have to be Cheon Inho? Aren't you curious?】

When I turned my head, there was the Demon King of the Cinema sitting with his legs crossed, gulping down a Zero Carbonated Drink.

【No one would have expected a main character like that.】

Instead of answering, I gulped down the Zero Cola placed next to me. When I didn't respond to the provocation, he raised his eyebrows slightly.

Asmodeus, who was squirming, asked.

【How does it feel to be born as such a protagonist?】

"Are you saying this because I ruined your theater?"

【…】

"You little brat."

I continued to spit at Asmodeus as he furrowed his eyebrows.

"I can see what you're trying to do. You're going to start gaslighting me again by putting up another video like that. What if I'm not the real Kim Dokja? What kind of protagonist do people want?"

【…】

"Do I still look like someone who would ruin their life by being surprised by such words?"

【Oh my. You've grown.】

"I've grown. And I have no intention of dealing with you. I don't know about you, but."

【Then why are you here?】

All the littl Kim Dokjas sitting in the audience were looking this way, perhaps because they were enjoying the sight of us fighting.

I waved my hand lightly at them and said.

"I came to see my readers' faces."

I saw the kkoma Kim Dokja who poked her head out between the movie theater seats. The little girl with the unusually young face had a small name tag attached to her chest that was shaking.

rlaehrwk37.

I know who that 'kkoma Kim Dokja' is.

"How have you been?"

Noh Jiyoon.

The daughter of Dansu ahjussi.

"I'll definitely save you, so don't worry."

As if she understood what I was saying, the kkoma Kim Dokja's eyes quickly became teary.

Asmodeus muttered incredulously.

【When you say that, doesn't it sound like I'm the villain who kidnapped the kids?】

"Isn't that so?"

I glared at the guy for a moment as if we were standing against each other.

【I guess I have to admit that you're at least the main character in terms of guts. But I wonder if you'll be able to keep talking like that after seeing this.】

Asmodeus whistled as he said that. Then, the theater lights turned brightly, and the kkoma Kim Dokjas whose eyes had been shining in the darkness all bowed their heads.

【Let me introduce you to the new Kim Dokja who just joined us.】

At Asmodeus's signal, the kkoma Kim Dokja sitting next to him stood up with a tap on his small leg.

rlaehrwk244.

A name tag I've never seen before. It seemed like he was the Kim Dokja who had been captured by Asmodeus recently.

With snow-white skin and eyes that shone like stars.

Just like all other Kim Dokjas, he had all the characteristics of a Kim Dokja.

However, the kkoma Kim Dokja was holding a book in his hands.

【Do you want to know who it is?】

The moment I saw the title of the book, I got goosebumps.

It was someone I knew.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: TL-nim: I usually use the emoji ■ because I didn't find how to write ■■. Do you prefer that I continue using the emoji or switch to ■■ from now on?

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I looked into those innocent eyes and let out a sound without realizing it.

"Ah.”

However, he seemed to not recognize me and clung to Asmodeus with a fearful expression.

Then Asmodeus smiled.

【It's okay. Look. Isn't this someone you know well?】

The book he had been reading just a moment ago fell from the little boy's hands.

I blankly looked down at the title of the book.

『The World After The Fall.』

My head was dizzy. Memories of the times he and I spent together flowed through my mind for a moment.

Somehow, I felt like I could understand everything.

The reason I had met 'Jaehwan-ssi' a while ago, and the reason Jaehwan-ssi's colleagues were in this Fear Realm.

It was as if all those events were tied together by a single inevitability.

"Hyung."

The person who always emphasized fate to me. The one who said that no matter what, the protagonist should be given a chance.

However, the one who declared that this time he would write without using chance.

He looked up at me with a face that seemed to have found the real chance this time.

"Giyeon-hyung. Are you my hyung?"

Even though he had become a kkoma Kim Dokja, I could definitely recognize him. Just as I could recognize Gu Seonah or Kim Kyungsik, I could recognize him in the same way.

It was definitely Giyeon-hyung. The one who wrote 『The World After The Fall』 with me.

As I took a step closer, Giyeon-hyung took a step back.

Asmodeus, who had gotten up from his seat, spoke as if to stop me.

【That’s enough. Don't scare the kids.】

"What on earth did you do? You. Why is Giyeon-hyung here?"

【Hmm? His name shouldn't be 'Giyeon'.】

"Answer the question."

【I just brought a piece of the unlucky dead body. However, interestingly, the fragment had memories of you.】

In an instant, an image appeared on the screen with the sound of tsutsutsutsu.

It was a very old memory.

「"Hakhyun. Can I keep writing like this?"」

「"Don't worry."」

A voice in a hazy memory.

「"No, Hakhyun. Look. The views have dropped."」

「"Hyung, I told you not to be too excited or sad."」

「"Can I really not put in a coincidence? Should I just close my eyes and let him have a coincidence once?"」

Everything felt like a lie.

The memories that had been fading away in my head bloomed all at once like flowers blooming in season.

「"Hyung! See! I told you. I told you it would work!"」

A story before the scenarios began, even before the existence of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

「"Now I'll have something to eat. It's all thanks to you, Hakhyun."」

A time when both Hyung and I were poor. The life of those days when I just liked writing, and that's why I called myself a writer.

I stood blankly in the center of the theater and watched the story of those days. And I thought.

Where on earth does this universe connect from and to?

What else do I have to sacrifice to finish this long story?

"What do you want, Asmodeus?"

I slowly turned my head and saw Asmodeus's face smiling.

【It seems like we're starting to talk now.】

Asmodeus sat back down on his seat in the theater and took another deep sip of his Zero Cola.

【But I don’t really want anything from you. If I deal with you, you’ll just use another clever trick to get away with it.】

"That depends on what you do."

【Do you think this is the first or second time I’ve been treated like that by Kim Dokja?】

In the main story, Asmodeus was hit in the back of the head by Kim Dokja several times. And even the ending wasn’t so good. He called himself the 'Seeker of the End' and planned something meaningful, but he met a vain end.

I stopped thinking about that. Now that I think about it.

「What on earth was Asmodeus's ■■?」

Everyone in the <Star Stream> has their own ■■.

That must have been the same for Asmodeus. What kind of end did he dream of?

I don't know for sure, but what's certain is that he hasn't yet reached the ■■ he dreamed of.

"Do you also want the interpretation of the Natural Disaster-level Fear that I got?"

【Of course, that's a very interesting interpretation. Especially the stories that were laid out in advance to make that interpretation possible.】

The story that he mentioned while giggling was 'Heir of the Eternal Name'.

Asmodeus knows how that story was created, and who it sacrificed to be born.

"You'd better be careful of what you say. If you don't want the movie theater to be destroyed again."

【If you do something so rude, the kkoma Kim Dokja next to me won't be safe either.】

"Are you going to threaten me with Giyeon hyung?"

【What can't a little kidnapper do?】

I glared at him quietly and said.

"Well. You wouldn't do something like that."

【Why do you think so?】

"Because you don't look like that kind of villain."

I slowly looked back at the kkoma Kim Dokjas' faces. They must have been locked in this theater for quite some time already, but for some reason their expressions didn't look that dark.

It didn't seem to be simply because of the snack display case on one side of the theater or the sleeping bags lined up on one side of the seats. I can't quite understand it, but what can I say?

「These kkoma Kim Dokjas seemed to be following Asmodeus.」

Some of the kkoma Kim Dokjas were even standing next to Asmodeus and glaring at me as if they were reprimanding me. I waved my hand lightly at them and asked Asmodeus.

"What on earth is your purpose?"

I began to think that it was time to have a proper conversation with this guy.

No matter what had happened and how things had gone wrong, both he and I had already come this far. I couldn't deny that.

"If you're a 'Recorder of Fear,' you must have an 'One Sentence' that you want to write. Why on earth did you come up with something like this?"

【Wow, where did you hear such interesting information?】

As I watched the guy babbling, I recalled the moment when I first met him.

The day I was first summoned to his theater, he had been surprised to see me.

In other words, at that time, he didn't really know who I was.

「"This is... No way? You are..."」

After he found out who I was, he began to plot some kind of evil scheme, making me the 'main character' of this world line.

「"It's time to write a new 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 with your own hands."」

It was a plan to use me to change the story of the 41st Round to my liking and ruin <Kim Dokja's Company>.

"If even a guy like you can become a 'Recorder of Fear', then this <Star Stream> is really generous."

【...】

"You know? Your plans have all been a mess. They're inconsistent and never really succeeded."

【Say what you want. My goal has already been achieved to some extent. Because those I hate have suffered hellish pain.】

"Your goal isn't just to make <Kim Dokja's Company> despair."

The day I first met him at the theater, my readers and I received a sub-scenario from 'Asmodeus'.

When I opened the old log page, the scenario I received back then was printed out once again.

**<Sub-scenario (???) — Qualification of Record>**

Category: Sub (Individual)

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: You are possessed in this worldline through the 'Covenant of the Other World'. Cooperate with other possessors to prevent the imminent destruction and open up a new tale.

Time Limit: —

Reward: Return to the original worldline and receive additional rewards.

Failure: Death

Maybe when I first received this scenario, I should have noticed that he was the 'Recorder of Fear'.

"You want something at the end of this worldline. That's why you gave me and the readers this scenario."

【…】

"Is this scenario something that you agreed on with the other Recorders?"

Asmodeus's lips trembled slightly at my question.

I continued to ask.

"How many Recorders of Fear are there who act as 'RepresentativeKimDokja'? How many fragments of Kim Dokja have you kidnapped in this way?"

【It's amazing that I'm still surprised by you. How did you find out about that?】

"It's strange if I still don't know."

In this world line, in the 41st Round, a lot of strange things happened. And those 'strange things' started from the incident where 'a large number of readers possessed characters'.

It's clear that the 'Recorders of Fear' were behind that situation.

If it weren't for these guys who freely cross world lines and interfere with the story, such a large-scale treasonous act would not have been committed.

"Stop kidnapping the kkoma Kim Dokjas. You've done enough nonsense. Now let's slowly send the readers back to their original places."

【No.】

"Fine. Let's make a deal, Asmodeus."

【I said no.】

"You haven't even heard the terms of the deal yet?"

【No, I don't make deals with Kim Dokjas—】

"I'll help you write the 'One Sentence' you want."

A short silence flowed. Maybe it was because of his mood, but Asmodeus's mood had become a little sharp.

The air in the theater had settled down quietly.

Asmodeus asked.

【How do you know what the 'One Sentence' I want to write is?】

"I know."

I stared into Asmodeus's eyes.

I could see things that I hadn't seen when I first met him.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', smiles triumphantly.]

Maybe it's because my rank has increased.

[Exclusive trait, 'Record Repairer', activates!]

Maybe it's because my understanding of the 'Recorders of Fear' has increased.

[Recorder of Fear, 'Demon King of the Cinema', expresses his displeasure at you.]

Of course, he's still stronger than me. Of course, he's a Demon King, and a 'Recorder of Fear' with the power of an Outer God.

Even so.

"You don't seem 'terrible' to me anymore."

I wasn't scared of him anymore.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', is activated!]

[Your understanding of the target is very high!]

「"...Ah, call me again."」

「"Don't be so cautious. There are no other Constellations."」

「"Demon King of Salvation... You seem to be mistaken about something right now, but I will—"」

「"Good. Okay, I'll hold out for today."」

The guy's records began to float before my eyes in real time. From the moment Kim Dokja and Asmodeus first met, until the guy who had been wandering the Dark Dimension died.

【Wait.】

In that distant history, I understood Asmodeus.

The guy's eyes were trembling as he looked at me. The guy who became a 'Recorder of Fear' knew. That I was reading him right now.

【Stop.】

That all of his history was intertwined with me, one by one.

【I told you to stop, Kim Dokja!】

Asmodeus, who had finally grabbed Giyeon-hyung by the collar, growled at me.

I released [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] and asked.

"Do you have any intention of making a deal now?"

【Fuck. Do you know? You are the one who is more suitable to be a Demon King than anyone else.】

"That's right. You are the Demon King in reality."

A brightly lit theater.

Our shadows stretched out and fell on the white screen.

We looked at each other's shadows for a moment. Two beings with different wants and different ways of living.

【Okay. Let's make a deal.】

Even so, both shadows looked like Demon Kings.

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After a while, we made a contract through the 'Existence Oath'.

【What you want is the 'Kim Dokja Fragments' that I have, right?】

"That's right."

【Then let's start the first deal lightly.】

The guy said. He said he couldn't give me all the 'Kim Dokja Fragments' that he had. However,

【The only thing I can give you right now is this guy. Take him.】

A kkoma Kim Dokja who suddenly rose up sat on my shoulder.

At first, the little boy kept turning around as if he was uncomfortable, but soon he settled down and placed his chin on the book he was reading on my head.

"Giyeon-hyung."

There was no response when I spoke to him.

Sometimes he would tremble as if he was reading a certain passage, and sometimes he would laugh quietly as if he was having fun.

If possible, I wanted to protect him by putting him in the [Fourth Wall], but for some reason, he refused. Maybe he had a scene he wanted to see while staying next to me.

【My terms of trade are simple.】

"Tell me."

To be honest, I was nervous that he would suggest ridiculous terms, but surprisingly, Asmodeus's terms were not bad.

【When the 'King of Fear' appears in front of you, you must call me.】

"Okay. If that's all."

According to the interpretation of the prophecy, the 'King of Fear' he was talking about meant 'Second Kim Dokja.' It was obvious that he would show up and do strange things, but if it was just that, it wasn't a bad condition.

Asmodeus curled his lips as if he had read my thoughts.

【I don’t know if you’ll be able to survive until then.】

“Don’t you know that if I hear something like that, I’ll definitely survive?”

【Well. This time, it won’t be easy even for you. There’s something you absolutely must overcome in order to meet the 'King of Fear'.】

"Who is that?"

【Who would that be?】

When did it start? The scenery in the movie theater was gradually becoming blurry.

I suddenly realized something.

Ah, I see.

[The Recorder of Fear 'Demon King of the Cinema's turn will soon end.]

Asmodeus’s laughter was heard.

【Wake up, Kim Dokja. If you don’t want him to take away all the 'history' you’ve built.】

It was finally time to meet Cheon Inho from the 40th Round.

[You entered the room of the Recorder of Fear 'Evil Sophist'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 837 Episode 43 Transcendent Alliance (6)

Cheon Inho in the 40th Round.

His nicknames are the 'Evil Sophist' and 'The One Who Deceived the Stars'.

I don't know why he was given those nicknames. All I know is a very small amount of information about him.

That he was a rascal in the 3rd Round, and a great villain in the 40th Round.

That he almost became Yoo Joonghyuk's comrade for a short while.

That he had a showdown with Yoo Joonghyuk before the ending of the 40th Round.

And that he may have survived and continued the scenarios even after Yoo Joonghyuk regressed.

「He is the 'Evil Sophist' and the 'One Who Deceived the Stars'.」

Memories that whirled in my head.

Memories I had experienced through the Time Fault slowly came to mind.

「"In my next life, I want to ride the Regressor Bus and live comfortably."」

In the Fear's 'Subway on the Way Home from Work', I briefly experienced the 40th Round where Cheon Inho lived.

Actually, it's called 'experience', but I lived in the 40th Round for almost 3 months.

There, I became Cheon Inho, and I endured for 3 months with Yoo Joonghyuk, who was being chased by the Blood Cult.

「"Help me in this round."」

Why did the Second Kim Dokja want to see Cheon Inho's story?

"Cheon Inho."

Why, out of all the 'characters', did I possess 'Cheon Inho'?

"Cheon Inho?"

I carefully called out his name.

The room with the lights off was dark and dreary. It had no sense of life, as if it had been abandoned for a long time.

As I took another step, the entire room shook lightly as if an old beast was groaning. With the bright lights coming in, a room about thirty pyeong in size came into view.

[NOTE 1]

The first thing that caught my eye were the various shaped masks hanging on the wall.

"Ah."

Giyeon, riding on my shoulder, made a strange sound. When I lowered my hyung, who was wriggling on my shoulder, to the floor, he stood in front of the masks on the display stand and started to flutter.

"Ah."

"Do you want to touch the masks?"

"Ah."

"Take them out?"

"Ah."

"Don't cry like Biyoo."

I sighed and handed one of the masks to Giyeon.

The mask he chose was shaped like a small weasel. He must have really liked that mask, because he laughed heartily while wearing it and ran around the room.

I also followed Giyeon and slowly observed the masks. Some of the masks were new to me, and some looked familiar.

There were masks that resembled the Twelve Zodiac Signs, and there were masks that resembled Constellations. There was a mask that looked like Dionysus from <Olympus>, and another that reminded me of Hades from the <Underworld>.

Another mask resembled Surya from <Vedas>.

Suddenly, Cheon Inho's nickname came to mind. 'The One Who Deceived the Stars'.

Maybe all the masks here were a collection of people Cheon Inho had disguised as.

With that thought in mind, as I looked at the masks, this room felt empty again.

Cheon Inho must have always disguised himself, just like I had done.

If Kim Anna had heard, she would have said, "Are you sympathizing with the world's worst villain right now?" and given me a good scolding, but I couldn't stop the thought that suddenly came to my mind.

Maybe I too was born a villain. Cheon Inho, who became someone else and lived controlling people. What kind of ending did such Cheon Inho want to see in the end?

After looking around the room, we stopped in front of a small glass display case. There was a red coat on display in the display case. It was the same coat that Cheon Inho wore in his final fight with Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Ah."

"What?"

"Ah."

"Take it out?"

"Ah!"

"Put it on? Right now?"

Giyeon kept nagging, so I reluctantly took the coat out. I put my arm in the sleeve and put it on lightly, and the coat naturally wrapped around me as if it had been mine from the beginning.

[You are wearing the item 'Infinite Dimension Space Coat'.]

'Infinite Dimension Space Coat' like Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk's.

However, there was one thing I realized when I actually put the clothes on.

These clothes weren't originally red.

The deep scent of blood that I could feel from the clothes, the white fabric that concealed that scent remained here and there. I was sure. This coat was originally white.

At that moment, Giyeon grabbed my hand. When I turned around in surprise, Giyeon was standing there, pointing to the full-length mirror next to me.

"Ah."

"Can't we stop here…?"

In the mirror, Giyeon and I were reflected.

The small Kim Dokja and the big Kim Dokja.

At first glance, we looked like father and son, holding hands.

That's when the mirror began to ripple.

I instinctively grabbed the handle of 'Unbreakable Faith' while holding Giyeon's hand.

The next moment, my face in the mirror distorted and changed into a familiar face.

It was a face I knew well.

The first time I saw it after possessing a character in this world - the face reflected on the subway screen door.

【You've changed a lot.】

I got goosebumps just from hearing the voice. I instinctively had to judge whether the guy had used [Incite]. Fortunately, I didn't feel any sign of [Incite].

【Excellent judgment.】

"…"

【You have to check before using [Incite]. Am I already being [Incited]?】

"Do you have to do your first greeting like this?"

Then, Cheon Inho in the mirror smiled with his eyes wide open.

"Stop joking around and get out of there quickly. It's creepy to hear you say that in the mirror."

【I can't get out of here.】

"Why?"

【Because there's already an entity occupying my body.】

I see. Is it because I'm occupying your body that you can't get out?

Then, Asmodeus's words suddenly came to mind.

「Wake up, Kim Dokja. If you don't want him to take away all the 'history' you've built.」

Could it be that this guy could take my body away whenever he wanted?

Cheon Inho read my thoughts and said.

【It seems like you heard bad words from a bad demon king. Don't worry. I don't plan on taking your body away right now.】

"It sounds like you plan on taking it away someday."

【That's up to you.】

I shot back with a grin.

"Do you think that kind of threat will work? This is already my body. It's filled with the legends I've personally built. Even if you're the 'Recorder of Fear', you can't easily take away someone else's legends. The probability of the <Star Stream> doesn't allow that."

I said that, but I was actually anxious. It was because of the words that the God of Despair, Chunghuh, had left behind.

「They can 'Rewrite' this world.」

If the 'Recorders of Fear' really had that kind of ability, it could have been possible for them to take my body, despite the aftermath of probability.

Cheon Inho didn't really confirm or deny what I said, and just smiled ominously and said this.

【You look really anxious, Kim Dokja.】

Damn bastard, where did you boil Kim Dokja and eat him?

[NOTE 2]

I responded with a pretended calm face.

"Why did you call me? Do you also want the interpretation of the 'Natural Disaster-level Fear' that I have?"

The other three 'Recorders of Fear' all had their own purposes for calling me.

Lycaon called me as a warning, Bicheonhori called me to get the interpretation I had. And Asmodeus just seemed to want to screw me over.

Then why did Cheon Inho call me?

"If you want this 'interpretation', I'm willing to make a deal with you."

I also had a purpose for coming here.

「To gain the power of Cheon Inho in the 40th Round.」

I still remembered the scene I saw through Anna Croft's [Past Sight].

In a world where all the stars had fallen, Cheon Inho was on par with the powerful Yoo Joonghyuk before the end of the world.

He and I were using the same body, and we had become stronger based on the same skills.

In short, the '40th Round Cheon Inho' was a kind of peak that this body could reach.

If I could just quickly gain that power, honestly, I would have tried to take on any enemy waiting in front of me. But Cheon Inho had a somewhat indifferent expression.

【That interpretation certainly has some interesting aspects, but honestly, I'm not really interested.】

It seems that not all the Recorders of Fear wanted my interpretation. However, since it was one of the answers I expected, I wasn't flustered.

"Then let's make a deal. I'll help you complete 'One Sentence'. In return—"

【I don't need any help.】

"What?"

【I've already completed 'One Sentence'.】

This time, I couldn't help but be flustered. I wanted to know what the One Sentence he had completed was. At the same time, I didn't want to know.

【I guess why you came here. You want the 'Time Fault' that I have. Is that right?】

I nodded for now.

【You already have a ticket to that 'Time Fault'.】

Something suddenly came to mind.

When I returned from the '40th Round' via the 'subway on the way home from work', I received a message.

「I gained the right to read the ending of the Evil Sophist. Could that message have been some kind of permission?」

But Cheon Inho's next words were strange.

【Because we've already 'made a deal' with each other, haven't we?】

"What?"

【You don't remember anything. Well, that's only natural.】

"What do you mean?"

【Kim Dokja.】

Cheon Inho's eyes were shining darkly like an abyss.

【Do you really want to know?】

I felt a sense of déjà vu as if I had been asked a similar question before.

【Why are you here, why did you have to be elected, why did all these stories come into being, are you really curious about that?】

"I—"

【You don't necessarily have to know the whole story to reach the ending.】

Cheon Inho continued speaking in a voice that made it hard to read his intentions.

【Isn't it painful enough for you just to know who you are?】

Come to think about it, it was when I realized that my origin was 49% Kim Dokja. It was thanks to Cheon Inho in front of me.

【When necessary, just wear a mask. Constantly incite yourself, incite people. Deceive the world. Then—】

"To deceive the world well, you must first know the world well."

Cheon Inho closed his mouth.

"And for fuck's sake, I am you now."

【…】

"To become strong like you, I must also know who you are."

We looked at each other for a moment.

I couldn't define the emotions that flashed through his eyes.

Anger, hatred, despair, sadness. I couldn't express the emotions he felt in any words. That's why,

【If you really think so.】

At that moment, Cheon Inho looked like a 'Fear' to me.

【Start writing 'again' from now on.】

"What?"

【All the answers you're looking for are at the end of the story you're going to write again.】

And then a message came.

[The turn of the 'Recorder of Fear, the 'Evil Sophist' will soon end.]

I shouted urgently.

"Wait a minute. Explain it clearly! What do you want me to rewrite?"

【Until the rewrite is complete, I'll keep this cute friend with me.】

"What?"

When did it start? Giyeon-hyung, who had been holding my hand tightly, had disappeared.

"This damned bastard—"

The images of Cheon Inho and Giyeon-hyung holding his hand in the mirror began to blur.

【Ah, let me give you one last piece of advice.】

I hurriedly reached out to the mirror. But a strong spark repelled me.

【Do not trade the newly acquired 'interpretation' with other recorders.】

Those were Cheon Inho's last words.

The spark disappeared, and I was left alone in the mirror.

Wearing a red coat, I looked vaguely like Kim Dokja.

[The turn of the Recorder of Fear 'Evil Sophist' ends.]

The scenery of the area changed like waves, and I returned to the 'Room of Time Fault' before I knew it.

It seemed like a lot of time had passed in the meantime, and all the Transcendents that had been waiting for me had disappeared somewhere.

I felt empty somehow.

"Damn it."

I hadn't accomplished anything properly.

I hadn't met Han Sooyoung, my goal when I first entered, and I had barely gotten any information about the Second Kim Dokja.

Of course, I had heard some meaningful information about the 'Recorders of Fear', and I had secured the right to use the 'Time Fault', but... something was missing.

What if I had been Kim Dokja?

If I had been a proper Kim Dokja, I would have definitely gotten better results than this. I would have been able to get items from Bicheonhori and Asmodeus with plausible words, and I wouldn't have had my hyung–Giyeon taken away by Cheon Inho.

But I couldn't do that.

Maybe I should go in and meet the Recorders again, even now...

Woong, woong.

That's when my smartphone rang.

I thought it was the First Kim Dokja, so I turned on the screen, but there was no contact.

Instead.

['The Fear Realm Guide that Even a Squid and Sunfish Can Understand' has been updated.]

Update news for the 'Fear Realm Guide'. By the way, this 'guide' was updated in real time.

[The 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' entry has been updated.]

The Founder of the Absolute Throne.

The update details happened to be about the Outer God that I had hunted.

I opened the guide and looked for related entries.

And.

---

Part of the document was modified by SVRP.

SVRP. PW ???

Natural Disaster Fear – Founder of the Absolute Throne

Most of the records themselves were things I knew. An old Outer God of a natural disaster. The Outer God that created the 'Absolute Throne', and the lawbreaker of the scenario...

But there was a strange link at the end of the text that I had scrolled down for a long time.

**[Hidden records]**

Hidden records? I absentmindedly clicked on the link and the records opened.

I read the records absentmindedly. Somehow, it felt unrealistic, so I closed the window and opened it again.

The content did not match the guide's content at all. Nevertheless, the record was clearly written there, waiting to be read by someone.

I read the record out loud.

---

Good job.

It was not written who wrote the record. Nevertheless, it was clear who wrote it.

I read the two syllables over and over again. Then I slowly got up from my seat. It occurred to me that this story was not over yet. Because neither she, nor I, nor countless other Kim Dokjas had given up on this story. But.

"Disciple!"

At that moment, those running from afar seemed to have different thoughts from me. The Transcendents ran in front with faces that seemed to have already given up on something. I lightly bowed to Cheok Jungyeong.

"Did you meet the Recorders?"

"Yes. But what happened?"

Before Cheok Jungyeong could answer, the God of Despair Chunghuh, who was nearby, cut him off.

"What on earth were you talking about with the Recorders?"

After hearing Chunghuh's words in a panic, I realized something belatedly.

I looked around the empty space over and over again.

When on earth did it start?

"The End has begun."

The countdown above my head disappeared.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Pyeong; refers to a size measurement, specifically of space like a house or apartment in Korea.

Note [2]: Here he is refering to Kim Dokja's cunningness.

# 838 Episode 44 Evil Sophist (1)

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There were clearly '21 days' left in the countdown before I went in to meet the Recorders.

There was no way 21 days had passed in that short time, and unless a new Fear had occurred in the countdown, the current situation was clear.

「I touched something in the 'Fear Realm'.」

But no matter how much I thought about it, I couldn't figure out what I had done wrong. All I did was meet the Recorders, and make a few of them a little angry (was that really the problem?).

And all I did was fail the deal...

I opened my palm and looked down at the interpretation of the 'Fear of Natural Disaster' that was sparkling.

"You. Didn't you 'trade' anything?"

Chunghuh's expression as he looked at me was strange.

For a moment, the Transcendents looked at each other.

"No, no one told you, did they?"

"I thought it wasn't really necessary to tell you. There's never been a case like this before."

"There's a newbie who refuses to make the Transcendent Leap?"

Cheok Jungyeong, who was watching me from the side, touched his forehead.

Kyrgios opened his mouth with a sigh.

"If you don't deal with anyone in the 'deal' with the Recorders, you will incur the wrath of the 'Fear Realm'."

The wrath of the Fear Realm? Why? Because I didn't deal with the Recorders?

Chunghuh nodded and added.

"Maybe that's why the countdown disappeared."

"Did I really cause the apocalypse?"

Now, even if I were called Kim Apocalypse-ssi after Kim End-ssi, I would have nothing to say. Damn it.

Even in the midst of the destruction of the sky cracking open, Chunghuh added with a hollow laugh.

"Don't think like that. It was all going to happen someday."

The screams of the Outer Gods were heard from all over the entrance to the Time Fault. Some of them were already sticking their heads or tentacles out of the Fault door.

"They're popping out! Stop them!"

"Damn it! This is a Natural Disaster!"

"We need the protection of a Captain!"

Looking at it this way, this 'Time Fault' looked like a huge prison for Outer Gods.

There were Outer Gods running wild in each Fault, and the Transcendent Alliance was exterminating them.

A strange thought suddenly occurred to me.

「Why does this place exist?」

What on earth was the Second Kim Dokja trying to do by gathering them together?

Why did he create a place called 'Fear'?

I don't know, but I'll find out soon.

If the doomsday prophecy is true, and if the disappearance of the countdown means the prophecy has come true, then the 'Second Kim Dokja' will appear before my eyes soon.

The problem is.

"Kkaaaaaaah!"

"They're popping out here again!"

Before that, all the Transcendents were going to die.

Before I knew it, all the Captains around me were busy exterminating the Outer Gods trying to escape through the door.

But no matter how hard the Transcendents tried, it was impossible to stop the many 'Time Faults' from going wild. From the 'doors' above that no one had touched, unidentified Outer Gods were jumping out one after another, making terrible groans.

【Gyaaaaaaah!】

An Outer God that looked like a hybrid of Medusa floated through the air and suddenly rushed toward me. I hurriedly took out my 'Unbreakable Faith' and tried to swing it, but something was moving toward it faster than me.

With a crack, Medusa's entire body was sharply torn apart.

A streamlined tail blocked my path as if protecting me.

It was a Disaster-level Fear, the 'Tooth Fin'.

The guy who had disappeared on the subway home had managed to chase me all the way here.

"Oh, that's the Tooth Fin? You managed to tame that guy?"

When I turned my head, there was Lieutenant Ryunard. It seemed like he had a pretty intimate relationship with the Fears, so Ryunard patted the nose of the Tooth Fin a few times and added,

"By the way, the End has come again."

It was a tone that made it seem like it wouldn't be strange if 'The End' were changed to 'weekend'.

As if he was used to this situation, Ryunard stood next to me, swaying, and looked up into the air.

"I tell you, it's spectacular every time I see it. Look at that. Isn't it even cooler when everyone just lets it go?"

I wondered if it was okay to keep saying such crazy things when all the Transcendents were dying, but when I thought about it carefully, it wasn't so strange.

Weren't all the Transcendents a group that had a screw 'exquisitely' missing from their heads in the first place?

"I don't know if I can put it that way."

When I looked at it this way, this 'End Zone' seemed like a giant terrarium of Outer Gods.

A cosmic fishbowl filled with gods who were abandoned in the main story and rejected in the scenario. In that fishbowl, the Outer Gods were pouring out their anger toward the world without hesitation.

Another Transcendent was torn in half. Eyes widened in disbelief. He must have been a famous master in the <First Murim>, but he was ending his life in a place no one would remember.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is strongly activated!]

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', warns you.]

Is it proof that I am also becoming a part of this Fear Realm that I am becoming indifferent in the face of death?

I opened my mouth as if to resist.

"If we leave this, we will all die."

"We will die."

"You will die too."

"Me, Chunghuh-nim, Karlton. You. We will all die."

The expression 'die' was so indifferent that I looked back at him without realizing it. Ryunard smiled brightly.

"This isn't my first time dying. Oh, you, newbie, are you a little different?"

Strictly speaking, this wasn't my first time dying, but no matter how many times I've died, I don't want to die again.

"Is there really no way to stop it?"

"A way to stop it…"

Ryunard said, admiring the pure white light scattering across the sky.

"There's no way to stop the apocalypse, but there is a way to return it to its original state after the apocalypse."

Is there such a way?

"See that door over there?"

The 'door' that Ryunard pointed to was hanging at the very top of the room.

A place where the tentacles and heads of the terrifying Outer Gods roamed.

When I squinted my eyes, I saw the round number written small next to the door.

[Round 1863-99.]

I doubted my eyes for a moment.

If what I thought was right, that door is, that is.

「Scenario 99 of Round 1,863.」

Just thinking about it gave me goosebumps.

That kind of Time Fault exists?

"Should I really go through that door?"

"Hey. If I go in there, I'll die too?"

"Really?"

"Do you see the small button next to that door?"

Upon closer inspection, there was a small black button next to the door.

"Yes. I can see it."

"Just press that. That's the 'reset' button for this 'End Zone'."

The reset button for the End Zone.

"If you press that, everything will be restored to how it was before the 'End Prophecy' occurred. Dead souls will come back to life, and the Time Faults that went wild will stabilize. That's the kind of Fear that has that 'effect'."

I stared at the black button for a moment and then asked.

"Who made that?"

"I don't know. Some say it's a gimmick created by a great old being, and others say it's a Fear created by the King of Fear in agreement with the Recorders. What's certain is that when neither one nor the other works, you just press that."

"Then why can’t I just press it now? While the damage isn’t too severe—"

"That button can only be pressed after the apocalypse is over. And to be honest, I don’t press that button very often."

"Why?"

"Think about it. Do you really think pressing that button will 'return everything to normal'?"

For a moment, my lower shins creaked.

With slightly unfocused eyes, Ryunard continued.

"Is it really true that the dead can come back to life? Is it really 'possible' to turn back time? If that's possible—"

"…"

"Is the 'me' who died and came back to life really the same as the 'me' before? Who can guarantee that? If it's possible to guarantee that… what on earth is 'me'?"

A strange chill ran over me. Suddenly, the black button in the sky began to feel terrifying.

I thought I could understand a little why the Transcendents weren't pressing that button.

"If it doesn't work out, I'll press the button, but if possible, I'd rather it not happen. Hey, there! Take that!"

After lightly stabbing and subduing several of the approaching Outer Gods, Ryunard threw a chunk of Outer God into the Time Fault.

However, there were still too many Outer Gods that hadn't been sorted out. Even the Outer Gods in the Upper Echelons were starting to stir, so the commanders looked tense.

Cheok Jungyeong, who had quickly sorted out the Time Faults in the Lower Echelons, quickly approached me.

[Disciple.]

Cheok Jungyeong, who was emitting a red aura from his entire body, glanced around and spoke to me.

[Escape from the 'End Zone'. It's not too late. It's okay if you escape alone.]

"Master."

[I'm fine.]

Cheok Jungyeong had a very solemn expression on his face as he said that. I could tell from his expression. No matter what happened, he would never run away from this 'End Zone'. To be honest, my relationship with Cheok Jungyeong was not long. His decision to make me his disciple was based on a misunderstanding, and I was just using him.

However.

"Master."

Still, Cheok Jungyeong was the first person to welcome me here.

[What is it?]

When this time is recorded in the distant future, I don't want it to be read that Cheok Jungyeong died in the 41st Fear Realm.

"If I had 'made a deal' with the Recorders, wouldn't the End have begun?"

[Maybe? Because it has been so far.]

Why does the Fear Realm get angry if you don't 'deal' with the Recorders?

I thought about it for a moment based on that fact.

The Fear Realm is the 'region ruled by the Second Kim Dokja, the King of Fear'. But why does such an unwritten rule exist in such a place?

"What happens if the Transcendent makes a deal with the Recorders?"

"If the Transcendent makes a deal with the Recorders, a new Time Fault will open."

「Why does the King of Fear want that 'deal'?」

For a moment, it felt like a light went on in my head.

"Master."

[I'll tell you how to escape now. Right now—]

"No, I won't escape."

[Your courage is admirable, but I can't let the master of the Three Swords be cut off here.]

"It won't be cut off. I think I know how to stop the End."

Cheok Jungyeong looked back at me in surprise at my words. His expression was a mixture of faint anticipation and criticism of his immature disciple.

I looked at that Cheok Jungyeong and asked.

"Master, what do you think 'the End' is?"

[The end is—]

Chuk Jungyeong hesitated for a moment and then answered.

[The 'Greatest Story' that a world can complete.]

I nodded.

Everything I thought from now on was just a guess.

"Only the 'King of Fear' who loves all Fears could love such an End."

I made the worst assumption that 'Second Kim Dokja', who had been trapped in the Fear Realm for a long time, had finally gone mad and was living a new story like this, enjoying such stories.

"But the 'Greatest Story' isn't always fun."

The End.

It's definitely an interesting subject. However, such subjects aren't always fun.

To a guy who sees the same end every time, the value of this 'End' probably isn't the same as the value of the first End.

Sadly, just like the weight of Yoo Joonghyuk's First and 100th regressions. In this world, sadness, joy, and emotion all fade away in repetition.

[What does that mean?]

"I have a story that the 'King of Fear' would find interesting."

That's why this was an 'adventure' worth trying.

I told Cheok Jungyeong the number of the 'Time Fault' I wanted.

[Hmm. That 'Time Fault' is...]

At Cheok Jungyeong's signal, the Transcendentals of the entire group began to move while escorting me. We pushed through the waves of Outer Gods rushing in from beyond the Fault, and we continued to advance.

[Here, disciple.]

Fortunately, the door was not far away.

[Round 40-99.]

Just looking at the scenario numbers gave me goosebumps.

Even the entrance to the Fault had a title written in an unfamiliar handwriting.

「The Evil Sophist.」

The moment I read the sentence, I felt the original price inside me react.

[You can read the Ending of the 'Evil Sophist'.]

I had already obtained the right to enter this 'Time Fault' from Cheon Inho in the 40th Round.

And finally, this Time Fault was—

「The story that the Second Kim Dokja was curious about on the subway on the way home from work.」

So I thought. If I enter this Fault, and if I can just catch the attention of the 'Second Kim Dokja', the 'End' might be postponed.

[There is an incarnation body suitable for you in this Time Fault.]

As expected. Cheon Inho in the 40th Round was still alive until scenario 99.

Since I've come this far anyway, there's no need to hesitate any longer.

The moment I took a deep breath and put my hand on the door of the Time Fault, Cheok Jungyeong asked.

[Are you really okay?]

"It's okay. It might be a little difficult, but—"

[No, there is already an entrant in this 'Time Fault'.]

"Yes?"

[To be exact, 'there was'.]

There was someone who entered the Fault before me?

When I turned around in surprise, Cheok Jungyeong answered with a somewhat displeased expression.

[A month before you came, a disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint visited the Transcendent Alliance.]

I got goosebumps for a moment. It was so obvious who Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's disciple meant.

But how could he have visited here a month before me?

If I had spent more time on the 'Fear' of the 'subway on the way home from work' than expected, it wouldn't be completely impossible.

No, it's more like that now.

"That guy... Did he enter alone?"

[Yes. Unfortunately.]

I blankly looked at the monitor of the Time Fault.

The monitor screen was completely dark.

Then, a log message from the Fault appeared at the bottom of the screen.

If that guy were alive, it would never appear.

[There is currently no Transcendent challenging the 'Time Fault'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 839 Episode 44 Evil Sophist (2)

What happened?

Why on earth is Yoo Joonghyuk in the Time Fault of the '40th Round'?

No matter how much I thought about it, there was no reason for it. The last time I parted ways with him was at the entrance of the Fear Realm.

I left the guy who hadn't fully recovered to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and fell into the Fear Realm.

But the guy followed me into the Fear Realm, our paths crossed, and he arrived at this 'Transcendent Alliance' before me.

And then he entered the Time Fault of the '40th Round'. Why on earth?

「Yoo Joonghyuk lost his memories from the 40th Round.」

I opened my mouth at the sudden thought. Now that I think about it, Yoo Jonhhyuk forgot most of what happened in the 40th Round as a side effect of the 'Story Imprint'.

What if he came to this 'Fault' to get them back?

I felt suffocated.

Damn it. Joonghyuk. Even so, what are you going to do if you challenge this?

In the 99th Scenario of the 40th Round, Yoo Joonghyuk's 'incarnation body' obviously won't exist.

If it's as we saw in Anna's [Past Sight], Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation body was defeated by Cheon Inho before the last scenario.

Then, it was highly likely that Yoo Joonghyuk had possessed another incarnation and had performed the mission of the Time Fault.

Damn bastard, I'd rather challenge that 'Fault' above.

[Round 1863-99.]

Even if I look at it again, it's a dizzying number, but if it were Yoo Joonghyuk now, it would have been better to challenge that side.

In the 99th Scenario of the 1,863rd Round, if he was lucky, he could have possessed Yoo Joonghyuk in the 1,863rd Round.

"It seems that 'Fault' is visible to you."

"Yes?"

Chungheo, who had suddenly appeared beside me, muttered while stroking his beard.

"Oh, didn't Ryunard say it? That Fault can't be seen by anyone."

Chungheo continued in a strangely dissonant voice.

"This world's 'Fault' can only be seen by those like me who came from outside, or by the Recorders who watch the world line. How strange. No newcomer has discovered that 'Fault' until now."

Only after hearing that did it occur to me that maybe Yoo Joonghyuk hadn't discovered that Fault.

Perhaps the incarnations from the 41st world line had a set type of 'Fault' that they could utilize.

Some Faults are visible, and some are invisible.

Just as you can't experience an event that you haven't experienced yet.

Even so, all of those events clearly exist 'together'...

"I'll say it again, you don't have to feel burdened. I can just press the reset button after everything is over. I've done that many times before."

"No. That's the same as 'regression'."

"Regression?"

"I don't want to save my comrade that way."

"Your comrade—"

"He's definitely still alive."

The monitor on the Time Fault wasn't showing anything. But I trust Yoo Joonghyuk.

It was none other than Yoo Joonghyuk of the '41st Round'. There's no way he would have entered the 40th Round without thinking.

"And I'm not going in alone, Kim Anna-ssi."

Anna Croft, who was trying to sneak away from behind at my call, turned around.

"Are you in your right mind?"

"You're not going with me?"

"I don't have an 'incarnation body' in that 'Fault'. If we go in together—"

"You can possess any incarnation and use it."

"That might not work! Didn't you hear what the seniors explained? If you recklessly enter a Time Fault without a proper incarnation body…"

"If the soul doesn't settle down, it could become an Outer God."

I know.

If we were not careful, both Kim Anna and I could have been stuffed with 'Catastrophic Fear'.

But she couldn't refuse this offer.

"Aren't you curious about the ending of scenarios number 99?"

"…"

"I'm saying that you're curious about what I, Cheon Inho, saw at the end of that damned 40th Round."

"You really..."

"I'm a coward. So please be fooled by that cowardice one more time. I think I need you to see the ending of that 'Time Fault'."

"…"

"If we're going to see the ending in this round, we absolutely have to know what happened in the 40th Round."

I silently grabbed Anna's wrist. Anna Croft sighed deeply and looked at Chunghuh with pitiful eyes as if asking for help.

I looked at Chunghuh and said.

"Please delay the end until I return. Please."

"Wait! Wait! Cheon Inho! Aah—"

[Entering 'round 40-99'.]

[The 'Time Fault' belongs to the 'Recorder of Fear, Evil Sophist'.]

…

[■■-grade Fear, 'Evil Sophist', allows you and one other person to enter.]

[The 'Time Fault' opens.]

---

The two people disappeared beyond the swirling door. Someone approached Chunghuh, who was silently watching the door close in an instant.

"Master."

"Karlton."

Karlton, who had the heads of Outer Gods lined up in a silver chain, stood behind him.

"It seems the newbies have come in."

"That's right."

"Why didn't you stop him? This isn't a Time Fault that two newbies can handle."

"It's not like anything will change even if they're here."

"That Fault belongs to the 'Recorder of Fear'. If you get trapped inside, you can't come back even if you press the 'reset' button."

"He said he hated regression."

"Huh?"

Chunghuh laughed silently and looked up into the air, then spoke again.

"Jaehwan, that guy hated 'regression' to the point of death."

Karlton also hesitated at the name Jaehwan.

Chunghuh continued.

"That guy also climbed that high tower to save his friend."

Karlton also knew well what that 'tower' was. The tower and the world they knew had already disappeared, but the back of someone climbing that tower was vivid in their memories.

"He was the guy who climbed the difficult path that no one took, even though there was an easy path."

Karlton smiled bitterly.

Longing. In this Fear Realm, it was an emotion that was endlessly vague and, above all, powerful.

"It reminds me of the old days. Do you think the newbies will succeed?"

"In this 'End Zone' where everything is useless, do success and failure have much meaning?"

A wave of Outer Gods gathered like clouds in the sky and surged toward the Transcendents.

Chunghuh silently drew his sword and began to slash at the air with a grin.

"I just hope he finds a 'good story' in this cliche End."

The moment he said that, the Outer Gods' heads all turned somewhere.

「The 'King of Fear's' gaze moved.」

The Outer Gods who followed their master were looking in the same direction as their master. That direction was, of course, where the '40th Round' Time Fault was.

Chunghuh added with a smile.

"Maybe he's already found it."

---

[You have possessed a suitable 'incarnation body.']

It was a familiar feeling. The same feeling as when I entered 'Fear' through the captain of the 'subway on the way home from work'.

[The final chapter of ■■-grade Fear, 'Evil Sophist', has begun.]

At that time, I was disguised as a masked person of the Blood Cult who was chasing Yoo Joonghyuk.

But what is this now?

[Warning! Your incarnation body is in a very unstable state!]

I thought I possessed Kim Dokja.

In addition, the incarnation's stories were completely destroyed, so it wouldn't be strange if I collapsed right away.

"Kim Anna-ssi."

I quietly called out to Anna Croft, but Anna didn't respond.

After briefly calling her, who might have become a 'Disaster-level Fear' Anna Croft by now, I slowly got up from my seat.

In that moment, something brushed past my head with a thud.

An arrow.

It was an arrow with an unusual 'force'.

"It's close! There's a guy nearby!"

Judging from the aftermath of the arrow's landing, they were incarnations with great energy.

They must be chasing Cheon Inho.

I had to run away somehow.

Even if the incarnation body was like this, running away was nothing. No matter what, this body was Cheon Inho who survived until the 'Last Scenario'...

Squeak.

I almost tripped and fell.

Why is this kid’s incarnation body still so weak? Is he really like Kim Dokja VER.2?

No, but it's scenario number 99, so how can his incarnation body be this weak?

[Your infirmity increases due to the influence of the exclusive trait 'Disease Acceleration'.]

It even seemed like his overall ability was lower than the last time I possessed him.

[Your overall ability has been greatly reduced due to the influence of the exclusive trait 'Weak Tongue'.]

My mind became complicated.

No. Even though his basic overall ability is low, he rode the combination of 「Disease Acceleration」 and 「Weak Tongue」 as his exclusive traits?

Are you crazy?

[Find it! Near here—]

Wait a minute. 「Disease Acceleration」 and 「Weak Tongue」. If I think about it carefully, I understand why he had these exclusive traits.

「Disease Acceleration is a trait that makes all traits' 'repeated cooldowns' zero in exchange for drastically worsening his status abnormalities.」

On top of that, 「Weak Tongue」 is a trait that increases the speed and power of 'Speech'-related skills in exchange for lowering his overall ability by half.

Combining these two allows for the so-called 「Magic Rapid Fire」.

However, Cheon Inho was not a magician, but an 'Instigator'.

In other words, this was a trait combination created with the idea of casting [Incite] first before the opponent could do anything.

I was impressed by Cheon Inho's boldness.

It’s a 'trait combination' that could send you to the afterlife with just one hit in this scenario.

No matter how much I think about it, this is a method that only someone as crazy as Kim Dokja could possibly use.

[There! Over there!]

And I was that crazy Kim Dokja.

"Yes, here."

Even though I was a total wreck, even though my incarnation body was a mess and my body was at the level of Kim Dokja — it was none other than the body of Cheon Inho, the 'One who Deceived the Stars' and the 'Evil Sophist' in the 40th Round.

I have [Incite].

If it's not another [Incite], but Cheon Inho's [Incite] that reached the end of the scenarios, what can't it do?

Just like I did with the Blood Demon, I can make them all kneel with subtle gaslighting and then crack the back of their heads.

I think that and get up.

"I finally found you, Cheon Inho."

What the heck, the Blood Demon I met last time was standing there again. Ah, was this kid alive?

Of course, I didn't listen to what he said and immediately activated [Incite].

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

Incite, which is displayed as 'level ???'. I was about to be amazed by his incredible skill.

[Your incarnation's durability is currently at its limit.]

[Your incarnation cannot use this skill at present.]

I tried to smile and took a step back.

Damn it, I should have tried this before.

I wondered why my incarnation body ended up like this, but it seems I had already been using [Incite] vigorously somewhere.

I waved my hand as if I was greeting a friend I hadn't seen in a long time.

"Oh, nice to meet you, Blood Demon."

"Nice to meet you?"

Blood Demon said with a grin.

"Yes. Nice to meet you. Cheon Inho, I am grateful to you back then."

"I don't know what you're grateful for, but I'm glad. Then, would you mind throwing me some of the remaining herbs? If possible, it would be better if it were the Blood Spirits you gave me before."

The Blood Demon's eyebrows furrowed at my words.

"Damn you. Anyway, thanks to you, I've finally gotten one step closer to the [Regression Law]."

"Ah, that ridiculous Regression Law. You're still researching it, aren't you?"

I slowly took a step back, looking around. However, no matter where I looked, the Blood Demon's subordinates were already surrounding me.

It was a disaster.

I didn't think I'd die in the 'Final Scenario' to the Blood Demon, not Zeus or Poseidon.

"Yeah, it's all thanks to you defeating Poseidon."

"Who did I defeat?"

The Blood Demon looked at me like I was crazy. Only then did I understand why my incarnation body had become like this.

Did I have a fight with Poseidon of <Olympus>?

I even took that bastard down?

"I don't know what kind of scheme you're plotting, but it won't work this time. So put down that thing you stole from <Olympus> and get out."

Thing? Only then did I notice the thing shaking around the waist of my coat.

"If you give me that, I'll really let you live this time."

I stared blankly down at the thing in question.

I thought it was some kind of secret trick left by Cheon Inho, but the moment I confirmed it, I cursed without realizing it.

"This damn thing."

Yoo Joonghyuk's head was hanging from my waist.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 840 Episode 44 Evil Sophist (3)

Killer King Cha Sungwoo, who had been sitting blankly, suddenly hit his head hard. Ji Eunyu, who was watching from the side, asked in surprise.

"What are you doing?"

"I was checking if my head was properly attached."

"Suddenly?"

"My head has hardened these days, so I can't remember the contents of the Book of Revelation well."

"You said you've read it a hundred times."

"Should I have read it a hundred and one times?"

Cha Sungwoo looked up into the air with strange eyes, then muttered in a voice that seemed to be intentional.

"Or... is it because that guy isn't here?"

Of course, Ji Eunyu knew who 'that guy' Cha Sungwoo was talking about.

With a light sigh, he looked around, and saw Lee Dansoo, Kyung Sein, and Cha Yerin all staring into the air with the same eyes.

As expected, they all had expressions thinking about 'that guy'.

"Is he okay?"

Kyung Sein said a word. "No matter what anyone says, it's 'Kim Dokja'."

Cha Yerin then chimed in.

"Kim Dokja dies easily."

The group's expressions turned pale for a moment.

"Well, he comes back to life, doesn't he?"

"He must have the resurrection trait, right?"

"I don't think he had that trait…"

A deep sigh filled the room.

It's already been three months and ten days since their leader, the writer, Cheon Inho, or Kim Dokja (the title hasn't been unified yet), went missing.

"How's the damage situation for this scenario?"

In the meantime, the group of readers finished another scenario.

It was a 'Monster Wave' type scenario where powerful 3rd-grade monsters appeared.

"It's not bad. We've become much stronger now."

Even though it was a '20th-level scenario', the group was now able to clear the scenario without difficulty. It was all thanks to the spec upgrade at the 'Recycling Center'.

"There were no rumors that Dokja-ssi had returned, right?"

"This time, I didn't see the Kim Dokja impersonator. According to Hyunwoo—"

With a squeak of the hinge, someone entered the room.

It was Ye Hyunwoo.

"Are you all doing this again? We're not like <Kim Dokja's Company>."

Lee Dansu answered with a laugh.

"You never know. If you think like this, you might meet Inho-ssi…"

"Right. Inho-ssi has [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]."

But no matter how much the group thought of Cheon Inho, they couldn't hear his voice.

"He's not really dead, is he?"

"No way."

"Then where is Inho-ssi right now?"

At Kyung Sein's muttering, everyone's eyes turned to the two.

The only two people in this room who had read the 'Book of Revelation' over a hundred times.

Ji Eunyu, who had caught their attention, spoke first.

"I think… he probably went to where the 'Time Fault' is."

Cha Sungwoo nodded as well.

"I think so too."

"Writer… no, Dokja-ssi is being chased by Nebulae right now. He had to find a way to get stronger while running away from the Constellationss."

"There's no other way than to become a Transcendent."

Kyung Sein nodded as if he understood, and Lee Dansu let the words slip away.

"Then how about we go find Dokja-ssi?"

Cha Sungwoo was the first to raise his head at those words. Ji Eunyu, Cha Yerin, and Kyung Sein followed suit.

However, there were those who shook their heads instead of raising their heads.

It was Ye Hyunwoo.

"Sir, realistically, that’s difficult. No matter how strong we become, we’re not strong enough to go to the 'Time Fault'. If we go, it’ll just be a burden."

"Why don’t we just borrow the strength of the characters?"

"They won’t help us."

At Ye Hyunwoo’s words, the group recalled the last words they had heard from Lee Jihye.

「 "We’ll act separately for the time being."」

Lee Jihye, Lee Hyunsung, and Shin Yoosung’s backs turned as they walked away with somewhat lonely and sorrowful expressions.

「"The master told me not to die!"」

'Don’t die.'

How nice it would have been if they had such instructions.

After Kim Dokja disappeared, the group felt like a compass with a broken needle.

"Can’t we go by ourselves? Heewon-ssi left like that too."

Jung Heewon left the group a month ago, saying that she would find Cheon Inho at all costs.

"We’re not Heewon-ssi. And I’m worried about her too. She’s the strongest of us all, but..."

Ye Hyuwoo’s expression suddenly hardened as he spoke. It was because he had noticed a huge group of dark clouds hanging over the window.

Tsk tsk tsk tsk!

An untimely spark was striking the clear sky of the Korean Peninsula. A huge hall slowly forming its outline around that spark.

Cha Sungwoo muttered, jumping up from his seat.

"Great Hall?"

Why is the Great Hall suddenly opening now? The 'Calamity' scenario had already ended, and there was no sign of a scenario related to 'Divine Power of the Other World' for the time being.

But the fact that the 'Great Hall' was observed...

"It seems like something has happened."

In reality, the Constellationss that resided on the Korean Peninsula were running around, issuing warnings to the group.

[The Constellations 'Maritime War Lord' is warning!]

[The Constellations 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is advising that you stay away from the 'Great Hall'!]

[The Constellations, 'Bald General of Justice', is diligently polishing his head!]

[The Constellations 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' narrows his eyes and glares at the 'Great Hall'.]

…

They didn't know what was happening, but if the Constellationss were that nervous, it seemed like something would happen in the scenario soon. Ye Hyunwoo, who was in a hurry to contact someone, said.

"I just got a call from the US and Japan, and they are observing the same 'Great Hall' there."

"So the 'Great Hall' is opening all over the world at the same time? What, the second half of the scenarios hasn't even started yet—"

Amid the confusion in the crowd, only Cha Sungwoo muttered without losing his composure.

"It seems that Kim Dokja is alive."

Ji Eunyu tackled the confident voice.

"How does that connect to that?"

"I can tell."

"Please stop saying that while smiling."

"Kim Dokja, what on earth are you doing?"

"I told you not to say that while smiling."

Ji Eunyu also looked up at the 'Great Hall' with anxious eyes, looking at Cha Sungwoo's snickering expression.

In fact, even though she said that, Ji Eunyu also agreed with Cha Sungwoo's words.

[The current administration is investigating the phenomenon.]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is starting to move.]

In this world line, and at this point in time, no one could have caused such a large-scale migration other than 'that person'.

'Author, what on earth are you doing?'

What was a little reassuring was that 'Yoo Joonghyuk' from this world line went with him.

'Are you okay?'

Ji Eunyu tried to recall Lee Hakhyun's face, which was now starting to blur, once again. The Lee Hakhyun in her memories just smiled silently, and didn't respond.

Ji Eunyu thought with her usual bitter smile.

'It's okay.'

---

No matter how much I tried to be okay, it couldn't be okay.

Why on earth is there a Yoo Joonghyuk head keychain on my waist?

I had to ask myself this question over and over again to accept reality in my head.

"Wait a minute, Blood Demon. I'm a bit confused right now, so I think I need to sort things out. So please hold off on attacking for a minute."

"What nonsense are you talking about—"

[Exclusive trait, 'Supercognitive Acceleration', activates!]

Fortunately, Cheon Inho's appropriate trait helped me out. When 'Supercognitive Acceleration' activated, the surrounding movements temporarily slowed down. To be exact, it wasn't the surroundings that slowed down, but my thinking sped up.

Anyway, I took advantage of that time to synthesize the information I had obtained.

One, 'Yoo Joonghyuk' from the 40th Round was already dead (i.e., he had regressed).

Two, <Olympus> was storing the dead Yoo Joonghyuk's head, and I stole it.

Listening to this, there's not much to synthesize. The latter information was even a bit strange.

Why on earth was <Olympus> storing Yoo Joonghyuk's head? No, was the 'dead Yoo Joonghyuk's head' something to store in the first place?

「Yoo Joonghyuk's body disappears with the light at the moment of return.」

If my head and fingers remember correctly, Yoo Joonghyuk never left a corpse after he died in the main story.

「Then why didn't this 'Yoo Joonghyuk head' disappear?」

When my thoughts reached that point, my head started to throbbed for a moment and memories came to mind. I realized whose memories they were.

This was 'Cheon Inho's' memory.

It was a series of events that had happened to Cheon Inho since I had last visited the 'Time Fault'.

「"Supreme King, do you really think we can become comrades?"」

The moment I heard the voice in my memory, my heart pounded again.

I wondered if what I had done had any effect on the actual 40th Round.

However, I shook my head as I confirmed the scene that continued in my head.

「"If you really wanted to see the end, you should have been ready to give up everything."」

Of course, the two of them did not become comrades. That's understandable. One side is the worst villain of the Ten Evils, and the other is the savior of the world.

They are beings who have no reason to join hands rather than oppose each other.

The two killed each other's comrades, and eventually stood on a single-log bridge that could not be avoided.

「"Is this how it ended up, Cheon Inho?"」

After that, it was history as I knew it.

As confirmed by Anna Croft's [Past Sight], the two fought their final battle. And at the end of the battle, Cheon Inho exhausted his hidden resurrection trait and survived alone.

In the end, the Instigator Cheon Inho succeeded in defeating King Yoo Joonghyuk.

「"Supreme King. What does that mean?"」

「"..."」

「"This is the last 'reset'. What does it mean that everything in the universe will be destroyed forever in the next round?"」

However, Yoo Joonghyuk, who was about to answer that question, had already left this round.

The problem was what came next.

「[The Supreme King is dead.]」

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk's body was engulfed in a bright beam of light, a group of Constellationss appeared from somewhere and aimed for Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation body.

「"Olympus!"」

They precisely cut off Yoo Joonghyuk's head and stole it.

「[Preserve it.]」

A burning sensation spread through the scene before my eyes.

That was the extent of my memory.

Is that so?

The reason Yoo Joonghyuk's head was preserved in its original state was because of <Olympus>. I thought that perhaps they had prevented his head from disappearing by using skills like [Special Preservation] or [Complete Stuffing], but I just found out that skills could be applied in that way.

Why on earth did <Olympus> want to preserve Yoo Joonghyuk's head?

Maybe they wanted to look into Yoo Joonghyuk's memories, or maybe they thought that the secret of his regression was hidden in this head like that Blood Demon.

So… damn it. If I delay any longer, my body will be torn in two.

"Wait a minute!"

[Exclusive trait 'Supercognitive Acceleration' is released!]

The Blood Demon's Fearsome blade grazed my shoulder. If I could only use [Incite], he was a guy I could have subdued with a flick of my tongue, but this is really unfair.

"I'll give it to you! I'll give you Yoo Joonghyuk's head!"

The Blood Demon's blade hesitated for the first time.

"Are you going to give it to me?"

"Yes!"

"But why are you looking inside?"

I smiled brightly.

Why did I search inside my coat?

Of course, Cheon Inho would have hidden an item like this.

[Use the item 'Roughly Murderous Magic Bullet'!]

"Take it!"

I threw the magic bullet in my coat with all my might.

While the great Blood Demon and his subordinates hid themselves between the nearby shelters, I moved my weak body and started to run away in a hurry.

Kwaaaaaaaang!

A loud noise erupted and my weak incarnation body rolled on the floor. I swallowed a cough and crawled away.

I can't die here. And for some reason, I couldn't let Yoo Joonghyuk's head be taken away here either.

"Chase him!"

More than anything, one certain sense made me move.

[The 'King of Fear' is looking at you.]

Right now, the Second Kim Dokja is looking at me. He's wondering about the story of this 40th Round, after stopping that damned doomsday banquet.

That's why I had to live. I had to somehow escape. I had to ask for help.

I let out a bitter laugh.

I'm Cheon Inho of the 40th Round.

With the damned Ten Evils, who on earth could I ask for help from? There's no way Cheon Inho would have any colleagues right now.

That's when someone's shadow appeared above my head.

"The signal was too late. The One who Deceived the Stars. Is that the head of the tyrant?"

I doubted my eyes for a moment as I looked at the fluttering coat on the hill above my head.

I couldn't understand.

How does this human exist in this 'Time Fault'?

"Kill... no, Kang Ilhun?"

No, wait. How could this human be Killer King? There's no way there's a Killer King in the 40th Round. Upon closer inspection, his unique rude smile and speech were somewhat different from Killer King's.

But my thoughts couldn't continue. Because the words that came out of Kang Ilhun's mouth were more shocking than the fact that Kang Ilhun was here.

"Yes, now I can revive the tyrant."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 841 Episode 44 Evil Sophist (4)

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At first, I thought I heard it wrong.

What are you going to resurrect?

"Why are you looking like that? Have you changed your mind now?"

I quickly took a deep breath and hid behind Kang Ilhun and said.

"Kang Ilhun-ssi."

"Yes."

"Do you know what kind of being Yoo Joonghyuk is?"

Kang Ilhun tilted his head and looked back at me as if he didn't understand the intention of my question.

"Is there anyone who doesn't know Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"You know that Yoo Joonghyuk is a Regressor, right?"

"Of course I do."

Of course, if it's the latter half of the scenarios, everyone would know that much. Then the conversation would be easy.

"Then you must know how much Yoo Joonghyuk doesn't fit with the word 'resurrection'."

The concept of 'resurrection' definitely exists in this crazy <Star Stream>.

For example, Kim Dokja successfully resurrected several times by using his own characteristics, and Nirvana also used a similar ability called 'reincarnation' by combining the power of the backstory and the story. Shin Yoosung, who did not have the resurrection trait in the 41st Round, was also reborn as a dokkaebi by Kim Dokja's design.

Considering these cases, it seems that in this world, if you can somehow preserve your 'soul', there is a possibility of resurrection.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk is an exception.

"That bastard, he already regressed. Have you forgotten?"

It is different from the cases of Kim Dokja or Shin Yoosung.

Yoo Joonghyuk's soul does not go to the 'Underworld' even if he dies. This is because his soul belongs to the 'Oldest Dream'.

In short, Yoo Joonghyuk's soul is no longer in 'this worldline'.

But Kang Ilhun looked like he didn't know anything about such things.

"So?"

"Yes?"

"Did you get hit in the head by the Blood Demon? Wasn't it your plan to revive Yoo Joonghyuk?"

I sighed inwardly.

My plan?

Cheon Inho, what on earth were you thinking while living in the 40th Round?

"The One who Deceived the Stars."

Kang Ilhun's voice calling me contained a subtle murderous intent.

"Me, Lee Dansu, Kyung Sein, Ye Hyunwoo... We came here only believing in you."

"Yes?"

"You didn't become weak-hearted after coming this far, did you? Of all people, you?"

Suddenly, too much information poured in, so I couldn't figure out what was what.

Let's say Kang Ilhun was like that. Why did Lee Dansu, Kyung Sein, and Ye Hyunwoo's names come up again?

I first organized the newly acquired information one by one and looked closely at the man in front of me.

[Incarnation, 'Kang Ilhun', is showing deep favor to you.]

Kang Ilhun. There was no doubt about it.

This person was the incarnation of 'Killer King'. The extra villain of Chungmuro Station —'Rumor Expert' Kang Ilhun.

However, there was one strange thing.

Kang Ilhun had a scar in the shape of a line on his neck. It was as if someone had attached the head and torso, the skin of a subtly different color. Looking closely, the color of his hands was strangely blue.

[The subject is currently in a 'living dead' state.]

Oh my. No way.

Kang Ilhun's eyes strangely glowed as he looked at me.

"To find out the secret of this world, to destroy the final scenario, I sacrificed my soul. I came here trusting only you. But now you—"

A voice like a flowing stream of water.

Just as I was thinking that this human might be better at [Incite] than me, a shout erupted from the cover in front.

"Give me Yoo Joonghyuk's head!"

The Blood Demon, who had regained his momentum, was running toward us.

"Head! Head! Head! Head!"

The sight of dozens of incarnations running toward us while shouting "Head!" was truly a sight to behold. If Yoo Joonghyuk's head hadn't been dangling from my waistband, I would have clapped my hands.

I quickly hid behind Kang Ilhun and said.

"Do something about it."

While Kang Ilhun was looking at me with a look of astonishment, the Blood Demon who had discovered us shouted.

"Kang Ilhun? You bastard Cheon Inho! It's true that you revived the Ten Evils! How dare you revive the Ten Evils with the body of the Blood Demon that I created—"

At the moment when I wondered what that meant, the Blood Demon's subordinates shot arrows.

Arrows with powerful energy.

The moment I thought I was about to die, Kang Ilhun stopped me.

Push, push.

Over a dozen arrows pierced Kang Ilhun's body in an instant.

I shouted in surprise.

"What are you doing?!"

"Are you worried about me right now?"

"I'm sorry, but you just became an arrow skewer? It's strange that I'm not worried."

Kang Ilhun looked at me as if he was looking at a strange creature and then added.

"Run now."

"There's nowhere to run, so where am I going?"

"What the hell are you talking about? Have you really forgotten the plan?"

At the same time as Kang Ilhun spoke, a portal opened behind us.

"Go. I'll buy you some time."

"Let's go together."

"Stop talking nonsense and hurry into that portal— ugh!"

I carried Kang Ilhun and jumped straight into the portal.

"You can't go, you guys!"

The long, stretched out hands of the Blood Demon barely managed to grab Kang Ilhun's nape.

Startled, I instinctively grabbed Kang Ilhun's head and pulled with all my strength.

"Kuaaaaah!"

For a moment, a scream that I couldn't tell if it was the Blood Demon's scream or Kang Ilhun's scream resonated. There was a sound like something was being torn apart.

I was rolling around inside the portal. My stomach turned inside out, and then I saw the portal's entrance closing in a whirlwind. The transmission had ended safely.

I held Kang Ilhun's torn head in my hands.

Kang Ilhun's head spoke. "Please put it back on."

With those words, Kang Ilhun's head closed his eyes.

Suddenly, I felt a sudden surge of fatigue.

I could see the faces of several people running towards me from afar. Was it an illusion? I could see the face of Dansu ahjussi, the face of Kyung Sein, and the face of Ye Hyunwoo.

I waved my hand in joy.

[Warning. Your incarnation has reached its limit.]

My consciousness went out.

I slowly regained consciousness at the sound of a commotion. The first thing I heard was the man's voice.

"He waved at us earlier, right?"

"Yes. Yes."

"What do you think?"

"Hmm."

"He finally turned around?"

"He might have hurt his head."

"No, it must have been a ruse. He's trying to set the stage in advance so that he won't keep his promise to us."

"You're going overboard with just one wave. Kyung Sein."

When I opened my eyes, I saw the three people backing away in surprise.

I stared blankly at their faces. At first, I thought I was dreaming. They were all faces I knew.

Lee Dansu.

Kyung Sein.

And even Ye Hyunwoo.

The first to react was Kyung Sein.

"Are you awake, Cheon Inho?"

Not only was the way she spoke, but I could tell the moment I saw Kyung Sein's eyes. He wasn't the 'Judge Heewon' Kyung Sein that I knew.

"What a pitiful sight. Kang Ilhun, whom I saved with great effort, ended up like that."

Lee Dansu and Ye Hyunwoo added a word each.

"Don't scold him too much. He went all the way to <Olympus> like that."

"At least Yoo Joonghyuk's head was recovered safely."

I stared blankly at the three of them before opening my mouth.

"Excuse me."

Was it because of my tone? Or was it because of my changed mood?

Ye Hyunwoo asked with an anxious expression.

"What are you planning? Cheon Inho."

"Yes?"

"Did you develop a new [Incite] method?"

"No, that's not it."

I was wondering how I should explain this situation, and then I noticed Kang Ilhun's head on the table next to me.

Come to think of it, Kang Ilhun had asked me if I had been hit in the head.

I decided to take his advice.

"I had a slight head injury. That's why I don't remember well."

"A head injury? You?"

The three of them made expressions as if it couldn't be true.

Ye Hyunwoo asked with a more serious expression.

"Did you get hit by the Blood Demon?"

"No."

"Then Poseidon?"

When I nodded, the three of them looked at each other and soon gave each other a look of agreement.

"If he had definitely been hit in the head by that bastard's trident, he wouldn't be in his right mind."

"I'd like to hear an explanation of the situation. What did I do to end up like this, and why is Yoo Joonghyuk's head here? Who are you—"

"You forgot even such basic things?"

"I'm sure I'll remember them anyway, but to save time, could you give me a brief explanation?"

The three of them still looked suspicious that I was acting. However, whether it was acting or not, Ye Hyunwoo realized that proper communication was impossible, and eventually opened his mouth.

"Okay. I'll explain it to you once, so listen carefully."

For about 10 minutes, I heard about the current status of the 40th Round.

After listening to Ye Hyunwoo, I chewed over the information several times. Then I slowly opened my mouth.

"So... the only humans left are me and the Blood Demon gang, and you are the 'Ten Evils' that I resurrected. Is that right?"

I had roughly expected this, but it was shocking.

"Yes."

"How did I revive you?"

"You used [Deceased Summoning]."

Deceased Summoning.

I never thought that Cheon Inho, in the 40th turn, would have that horrible skill.

I also knew a lot about [Deceased Summoning]. This skill was originally used by Yoo Joonghyuk, in his 1208th Round, who had transitioned to the 'Lord of Death'.

A skill that borrows the souls of a Giant Nebula by making a contract with its Underworld.

Depending on how you use it, it is possible to create a one-man army by gathering powerful incarnations of past lives as immortals.

It seems that these people were also revived by planting the souls I borrowed through [Deceased Summoning] into their blood vessels.

"But that skill isn't that easy to use."

「Deceased Summoning had some pretty tricky conditions.」

One was that there had to be a 'head' of a dead person. And the two—

"[Deceased Summoning] can only be used when there is a special contract with the Underworld. It’s not like I can summon just any soul and plant it in your body."

No matter how corrupted the Giant Nebula was, there was no way a piece of trash like Cheon Inho could make a contract with the Giant Nebula and the Underworld.

"Have you forgotten that there is no Underworld in this world?"

I looked at him with a dumbfounded face and asked back.

"What are you talking about?"

"Didn’t you destroy the <Underworld> by causing discord among the Nebulas?"

I gaped.

Ye Hyunwoo looked at me pitifully and added.

"The 'Underworld' doesn’t exist in the current world."

Ye Hyunwoo walked toward me and held out the tablet he had taken out from his bosom.

"Thanks to you, the world became like this."

The tablet was showing the CCTV screen installed nearby.

Countless evil spirits roaming the dead land. From the 8th level Specter to the 5th level Night Ghost, the entire Korean Peninsula was a paradise for Evil Spirits.

Is this what a world without the afterlife looks like?

What on earth did Cheon Inho want to do in this world, committing such acts?

"Why did I save you?"

"Because you couldn't clear the 'Last Scenario' alone!"

One memory came to mind at Ye Hyunwoo's words.

「"Ten evils. Help me. I need your help."」

Ten Evils.

I didn't mishear. The people in front of me right now were the 'Ten Evils' of the '40th Round'.

「Fourth Evil Kang Ilhun.」

「Fifth Evil Ye Hyunwoo.」

「Eighth Evil Lee Dansu.」

「Ninth Evil Kyung Sein.」

And.

「First Evil Cheon Inho.」

It was amazing that the small villains survived and became the Ten Evils, and it was strange that Cheon Inho was determined to clear the Last Scenario by saving them.

I checked the log messages to see what the Last Scenario was.

Scenario #99 of the main story was 'Destroy the Ark', but here...

**<Main Scenario #99 - Scheduled Ending>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: Destroy the Ark guarded by the Constellations within the time limit and reach the 'Final Wall'.

Time Limit: 30 days

Reward: Final Wall

> Failure: World Line Destruction.

I read and reread the main scenario. And I cursed inwardly.

Damn it.

[To clear the 'Time Fault', you must complete the 'Last Scenario'.]

Destroy the ark guarded by the Constellations and reach the 'Final Wall'?

Easier said than done. Is this really the Last Scenario of the 40th Round? There is no <Kim Dokja's Company> or Yoo Joonghyuk in this world line?

I asked again, trying to hold onto a glimmer of hope.

"Are there any Constellations that side with the incarnations? Like Uriel or Jecheon Daeseong."

"That's stupid. Where is a Constellationss that sided with an incarnation?"

"The ones who sided with humans all died during the last 'Apocalypse Dragon', right?"

Oh my. It was a truly hopeless situation.

Ye Hyunwoo said.

"But this time, you defeated Poseidon and brought back 'Yoo Joonghyuk's head', so we have a chance of winning."

Is it Yoo Joonghyuk's head again?

I sighed and shook my head.

"Yoo Joonghyuk's head is of no help."

"What nonsense are you talking about? Didn't you say that if only you could revive the Supreme King..."

"Resurrection itself is impossible."

I didn't know whether I should tell them the truth.

These extras who could finally dream of the end of this world. Could I tell these incarnations who had never been given proper ground in the main story that Yoo Joonghyuk's soul was not here, so we could not receive help from the tyrant, and that the destruction of this world was set in stone?

「And at that moment, a small spark flew in Cheon Inho's head.」

Wait a minute.

「Is there really no way to save Yoo Joonghyuk?」

I looked at Yoo Joonghyuk's head that was neatly placed on the table, then hurriedly looked up into the air. As if there was someone I couldn't see there.

Ye Hyunwoo, surprised by my actions, asked nervously.

"What's going on? Is this an attack?"

"Is there a body to connect to Yoo Joonghyuk's head right now?"

"There is a body, but didn't you just say that resurrection is impossible?"

That's right. If it's as I think, Yoo Joonghyuk can't be revived even if [Deceased Summoning] is used. This is because Yoo Joonghyuk's soul from the 40th Round has already left this world line.

But.

「What if, in this 'Time Fault', there's 'one more' Yoo Joonghyuk's soul?」

I thought of the monitor of the '40th Time Fault' that was completely dark.

What if that black screen didn't mean Yoo Joonghyuk's failure or death?

"Let's start [Deceased Summoning] right now."

So what if, in the '41st Round', Yoo Joonghyuk hadn't found a suitable 'Possession Target' yet?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 842 Episode 44 Evil Sophist (5)

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The so-called 'Supreme King Resurrection Plan' was steadily progressing.

Yoo Joonghyuk and resurrection. If the First Kim Dokja, the Demon King of Salvation, had heard about it, then even he would have said that there was no such thing as a connection, but...

[The 'King of Fear', is watching the Time Fault.]

It seems that our Second Kim Dokja likes this kind of story better.

It made sense. It is said that the Second Kim Dokja likes sad and desolate stories.

Just the setting that Yoo Joonghyuk was resurrected as a zombie by his worst enemy, Cheon Inho, and lived like a slave in a world that had already been destroyed would have made even the most desolate maniacs shed tears.

I don't know how much of a maniac the Second was, but in any case, the operation went smoothly.

"Cheon Inho?"

"Yes."

"Preparations are complete."

Kyung Sein placed the 'body' that Yoo Joonghyuk would use in the center of the empty lot. I looked down at Yoo Joonghyuk's body in the drum and asked.

"But do I really have to work here? Isn't there a safer place?"

"You're talking like you're full again. You know it's fortunate that we can use it here, right?"

By the way, we were currently inside the subway station 'Geumho Station'. I wondered why it had to be 'Geumho Station' out of all the places, but on the other hand, I also thought that this was a fate of its own.

Geumho Station.

The place where Cheon Inho became an 'Instigator' and the place where I first possessed him.

It was ironic that the only safe place in the Last Scenario where the Korean Peninsula was destroyed was the station where the 'First Scenario' began.

"Are you done recharging your skills?"

I nodded.

Of course, [Deceased Summoning] is my skill. I'm the one using it.

However, I was surprised when I looked at the incarnation body that I took out from the drum.

"Wait a minute. This incarnation body..."

A body that was trained to fit the scenario. Muscles that are normally not overly swollen, but hide explosive power in between.

There is only one incarnation that trains its body this effectively in the entire <Star Stream>.

"It’s Yoo Joonghyuk himself."

"That’s right."

"It must have been destroyed, so how did you save it?"

"When [Preservation] was used in <Olympus>, the skill was applied to some parts of the incarnation body."

It seems that the skill used to preserve Yoo Joonghyuk's head was also applied to some parts of Yoo Joonghyuk's body.

There were traces of the incarnation body being torn and patched up here and there. It seems that it wandered around the <Star Stream> with its major parts torn apart.

"I happened to know a story expert in the Demon Realm, so I asked them. Unfortunately, they also lost their life when they were attacked by the Blood Demon…"

A story expert in the Demon Realm.

I thought it might be Aileen.

Etica's store owner, the watchmaker Aileen. She died while mending someone's story until the end of the 40th Round.

Anyway, are the materials ready to summon the perfect Yoo Joonghyuk with this?

I took a light breath and opened my mouth.

"[Deceased Summoning] takes at least 30 minutes."

"I know. I've finished preparing in case."

Preparing in case?

Before I could ask what that meant, I saw Lee Dansu stretching his body as he went out toward the passage.

At the same time, a strange cry began to be heard as it opened.

I became a little anxious and asked.

"What's the situation?"

"Evil Spirits will swarm."

"Huh?"

"Deceased Summoning is a technique that borrows dead souls and implants them into the body. And since you destroyed the Underworld, there are spirits wandering around here."

"..."

"If a body capable of being possessed were to appear in the meantime, what do you think would happen among the Evil Spirits?"

I suddenly broke out in a cold sweat. So now, the Evil Spirits were going to come in droves to take over this empty body.

"But don't worry. We have Lee Dansu."

Eighth Evil Lee Dansu.

I also knew about the Lee Dansu of the 40th Round.

He was the vice-regent of the 'Salvation Church' that followed Nirvana in this round, but he betrayed the Salvation Church and became a pseudo-exorcist after being hit by Cheon Inho's 'Incite Escalation'.

"Oh! Oh! Oh! Oh! Oh!"

Lee Dansu, who was dancing roughly as if possessed by an animal, suddenly stuck a cane into the railroad tracks.

The bamboo spear of the missionary.

Wow, wait a minute. That's the one I gave you as a gift. You have it here too?

The moment I felt a strange sense of foreboding, a sacred aura burst out from the spear.

[Character Lee Dansu activates 'Absolute Divine Barrier Lv.???'!]

Absolute Divine Barrier.

I was really surprised. A member of the Ten Evils was using the ultimate magic that only Constellationss of the absolute good lineage—at least the Archangel’s throne—could use.

Ye Hyunwoo nodded meaningfully.

"That’s the 'Ghost Exterminator'—the Eighth Evil, Lee Dansu."

I nodded in admiration.

The 'Ten Evils' suddenly seemed amazing.

In the main story, they only appeared meaningfully, but they were all small villains, but here, they were really amazing.

As the [Absolute Divine Barrier] reached its limit and activated, the Evil Spirits that had been pouring in from outside began to scream and burn.

Maybe among the Evil Spirits burning there was Kim Anna-ssi, who had failed to possess them.

I tried hard to forget that fact.

Lee Dansu approached me with sweat dripping from his forehead and said.

"We can’t drag this on for too long. Get started quickly, Evil Sophist. The future of humanity depends on your decision."

I nodded and cast [Deceased Summoning]. After a while, Yoo Joonghyuk’s head was stuck to Yoo Joonghyuk’s torso with a dazzling light.

Ye Hyunwoo, who was watching the scene from the side, muttered in a trembling voice.

"To witness the resurrection of that 'Supreme King' in person."

"Now I can even try out a scenario."

"If Yoo Joonghyuk is here, there’s no problem."

I smiled bitterly because the three of them seemed to be expecting too much.

"Don’t expect too much. Honestly, adding Yoo Joonghyuk won’t break the Last Scenario all at once."

"What are you talking about? It’s that 'Yoo Joonghyuk'. The savior of the world, the strongest incarnation on earth. I can definitely expect it."

Aren’t the Ten Evils praising the main character too much?

I tried to make a pointless comment.

"Even so, it’s just a joke to me."

The three of them looked at each other at the same time at my words. Then, a loud laughter filled Geumho Station.

I asked with a slightly strange feeling.

"Why are you laughing?"

"Tsk tsk. If that's a win, then it's a win."

Cheon Inho definitely defeated Yoo Joonghyuk. I confirmed it in Anna's [Past Sight]. But Ye Hyunwoo was acting as if I was bragging.

"You really seem to have forgotten everything."

"What are you talking about?"

"You set up curse traps everywhere Yoo Joonghyuk went, and you poisoned the food he ate without fail."

"..."

"You installed [Propaganda Loudspeakers] everywhere and repeated the gaslighting in stages, and whenever you had the chance, you brought up the dead comrades of the tyrant to erode his mental power. For half a year."

I continued to listen to Ye Hyunwoo's words with my mouth open.

"When he fought you, the tyrant was barely able to use about twenty percent of his maximum power. And you fought him in peak condition."

"That's what he was like?"

"Then how did you defeat that tyrant?"

It was ridiculous.

That kind of secret happened in the 40th Round's battle I saw?

My shoulders, reflected on the broken screen door, looked so narrow that I couldn't help but ask.

"Am I weak?"

Ye Hyunwoo thought for a moment and then said.

"That's a difficult question."

"Be honest."

"Honestly, I'm not sure any of us could win a one-on-one fight with you..."

"Can you?"

"Yes."

Damn it.

I sighed deeply, and Ye Hyunwoo added.

"If you didn't prepare at all."

Prepare?

"If you prepare properly, none of us will be able to deal with you. When you're ready, you're stronger than any Constellations in the <Star Stream>. You even defeated Poseidon."

"Speaking of Poseidon, did I happen to catch him like I caught Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"You've been infiltrating <Olympus> for a year to catch Poseidon."

I didn't have the strength to be surprised anymore.

What on earth have you done to Poseidon in a year, Cheon Inho?

Did you feed him dirt?

That was when the feeling of the dazzling light flowing out of Yoo Joonghyuk's body changed.

[Call the soul to use for the 'Deceased Summoning Technique'.]

The full-scale summoning was finally about to begin.

I opened my mouth nervously.

"The incarnation I'm going to summon is the Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk."

The skill didn't respond for a moment.

Please, please.

[The spirit you summoned is nearby.]

I almost cheered.

[The spirit is suitable for the incarnation.]

[Deceased Summoning.]

There it is! As expected!

I held back tears that were about to well up and continued the summoning.

Ye Hyunwoo muttered while watching me.

"Honestly, I'm impressed."

"Don't talk to me since this is an important part."

"The tyrant will definitely kill you as soon as he wakes up."

I hesitated for a moment and looked at Ye Hyunwoo.

It was clear why Ye Hyunwoo was saying that. Right now, Ye Hyunwoo didn't know that the target I was summoning was not the 40th Round's Yoo Joonghyuk, but the 41st Round's Yoo Joonghyuk's soul.

"And yet, you planned to summon the tyrant again in order to clear the Last Scenario. You're probably the only incarnation in the world who can do that. So… I respect you a little."

"You can do it a lot."

"I'll do it a little."

I smiled bitterly, receiving the respect of the Ten Evils, but a new message appeared above my head.

[From now on, you can grant new characteristics to the summoned deceased's body.]

Huh?

[Please choose three characteristics to grant.]

Wait a minute. You can't just summon it, but grant it three new characteristics?

「...So, when your mastery of the deceased summoning technique reaches the ultimate, you can 'grant additional characteristics' to the summoned deceased.」

I'm sure I've read about that before in 'Ways of Survival'...

Wow, is this okay?

My heart suddenly raced.

Yoo Joonghyuk is already strong, but how much stronger will he be if he gains new characteristics as well?

[The level of the incarnation is too high, so you cannot choose to grant attributes.]

However, luck didn't always go as I expected.

[The incarnation randomly acquires three characteristics!]

[The random roulette activates!]

Damn, is this random too?

It doesn't matter. Since it's a free trait anyway, I'll be grateful if you give me anything.

[The incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk', has acquired a new trait!]

[Acquired the exclusive trait 'Stone Head'!]

[The intelligence and memory of the corresponding incarnation are slightly reduced.]

[The skull of the corresponding incarnation becomes very hard.]

I was dumbfounded.

"Stone Head"?

"Cheon Inho. What is that?"

"No."

When I thought about it, it might not have been such a bad thing.

It wouldn't be good for the already dangerous Yoo Joonghyuk to be smart.

Now there are two randomly granted traits left.

[The roulette moves!]

I prayed inwardly.

Please. Demon King of Salvation. Great King of Fear. Demon-like Judge of Fire. Please help me. Depending on what trait Yoo Joonghyuk gains here, the Last Scenario could be pretty fun, or it could be hell.

By any chance, if he really gets a trait like [Life of Power]—

[Incarnation, 'Yoo Joonghyuk', has gained a new trait!]

[Exclusive trait, 'Eating Bias', is gained!]

[The incarnation can only eat 'one' type of food.]

Eating Bias. It was a trait that was neither good nor bad.

A trait where the incarnation's abilities would decrease significantly if he ate food other than the designated food.

I thought it was fortunate. After all, that bastard Yoo Joonghyuk only eats things he makes.

Please, if only the last trait would come out well…

[Incarnation, 'Yoo Joonghyuk', has gained a new trait!]

And after a while.

I rubbed my eyes and thought.

Wait a minute.

Is this really what came out?

I stared at the trait name quietly. And thought.

[Exclusive trait, 'Uncookable', is gained!]

Oh my god.

[This incarnation can't cook.]

This was the moment when Yoo Joonghyuk, who was the first version unable to cook throughout Ways of Survival, was born.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 843 Episode 45 Ten Evils (1)

Three days had passed since Yoo Joonghyuk was resurrected. Usually, other Messiahs would perform some great miracle within three days of their resurrection, but our King didn't show any such signs.

The first time Yoo Joonghyuk spoke was when I suspected that the one I had summoned was not King Yoo Joonghyuk, but someone who happened to have the same name.

"I'm hungry."

"Yes. That's really nice to hear."

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't recognize me right away. I think it was probably due to the effect of the 「Stone Head」 trait.

An hour after declaring hunger, Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes began to glow a little. Then, after two hours, Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly clenched his fist at me.

And after about three hours, a question came flying in.

"What are you?"

"Wow, are you curious about that now?"

"I asked you what it was."

"I'm Cheon Inho."

"No."

"Did you notice?"

The penalty for the 「Stone Head」 trait is a 'slight' decrease in intelligence. Fortunately, it didn't seem to decrease enough for me to not be recognized.

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me for a moment and then said.

"You came for the 40th Round, too, didn't you?"

"You didn't do this because you knew I'd come, did you?"

Instead of answering, Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at his own body and asked.

"Why did you tie me up?"

"I'm preparing for an emergency. The other Ten Evils were worried."

"The other Ten Evils? All the Ten Evils except you died in the 40th Round?"

"I brought them back to life. Just like you."

As I seemed to be able to communicate with Yoo Joonghyuk, the Evils who had been cowardly hiding behind the various concealments of Geumho Station began to show their heads one by one.

"The One Who Deceived the Stars. Are you talking to the tyrant right now?"

"Stop doing useless things and use [Incite] quickly. We need to subdue him in the first place."

"Are you going to curse him first, or feed him some poison? I've already prepared to go up and kill him."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had confirmed the appearance of the Ten Evils, glared at me with his eyes wide open.

"You, did you use [Deceased Summoning] on those guys too?"

"Yes, yes."

"Why would you do something like that—"

"I don't know either. Strictly speaking, it wasn't my doing."

Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to have guessed the situation from my answer.

I shouted while exaggeratedly spreading my arms to reassure the Ten Evils.

"Now, the tyrant you've been waiting for has finally been resurrected. By the way, this tyrant has a low intelligence so he won't attack people recklessly. Oh, maybe it's the opposite."

"Cheon Inho!"

Ye Hyunwoo, who had become lost in thought, pointed behind me and shouted. There, Yoo Joonghyuk had released his restraint in an instant and grabbed me by the back of the neck. His strong grip made it a little sore, but I waved my hand lightly toward the Ten Evils, still hanging in the air.

"I'm safe. I'm not dead yet, am I?"

I looked back at the platform of Geumho Station while hanging on to Yoo Joonghyuk's hand. A cold wind blew from the tunnel toward Oksu.

I suddenly laughed. Come to think of it, it was also around here that I first met Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round.

"Are you debating whether to kill me again?"

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't answer.

Just from that silence, I realized that we had changed. We had been through a few things together. It may not be a great bond, but we definitely had a history together.

As Yoo Joonghyuk slowly put me down, the Ten Evils who had been hiding quickly started to run toward me one by one.

I looked at those villains and said,

"You know, right? You and I have something to check in this Round."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded. "If we don't check that properly..."

"We won't be able to see the end of the 41st Round."

I don't know about the scenarios that will unfold. I don't know if we will be able to survive this Time Fault or if we will be able to clear the Last Scenario.

But at least one thing is certain.

[The 'King of Fear' is watching your story.]

Even if our story fails, that failure will change a very important part of the universe.

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【I really didn't know the 'King of Fear' would be interested in that story.】

【Bicheonhori. If you had introduced the '0th Murim' better, this wouldn't have happened.】

【Huh, that guy didn't care about martial arts. Asmodeus. You should have promoted your 'Time Fault' well.】

Asmodeus laughed quietly at Bicheonhori's point.

【Anyway, it's interesting. I was also quite curious about the Time Fault of the 'Evil Sophist'.】

【This is not the time to laugh like that. If they really succeed—】

【The 'Evil Sophist' will be able to achieve his long-cherished wish.】

After a brief silence, Asmodeus muttered.

【He will finally become the ■■■ of this world.】

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[There are 25 days left until the end of Scenario 99.]

At a point when there were only 25 days left until the final chapter of the scenario, the Ten Evils and I were sitting on a bench at Geumho Station, absentmindedly.

Looking at Yoo Joonghyuk swinging his spear into the air from afar, Ye Hyunwoo, who was sitting on the bench right next to me, muttered.

"I didn't know I could really be on the same side as the tyrant."

Then, as if they had been waiting,

Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu nodded.

"That's right."

"I don't know why he's keeping us alive. What on earth did you say to the Supreme King?"

As expected, everyone was scared of Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You must have used [Incite]. Tell me what keyword you used on Yoo Joonghyuk."

In the meantime, Kang Ilhun, who had been resurrected, added a word.

I stared blankly at the Ten Evils who were just picking out pathetic words. Kang Ilhun responded to my gaze.

"What are you looking at?"

"I'm just curious."

In fact, back when I was writing the main story, I didn't even care what they looked like. That's understandable, because the role of the 'Ten Evils' was nothing more or less than an obstacle in the beginning.

However, in the 40th Round, the Ten Evils survived and were right in front of the 'Final Wall'.

And that was the problem.

Yoo Joonghyuk and I had to clear the Last Scenario with these guys. I checked the Ten Evils I learned about one by one.

First, the Evil Kang Ilhun.

Kang Ilhun, who was active as a 'Rumor Expert' in the 40th Round, controlled the public by becoming the speaker of Cheon Inho with his more developed [Rumor] skill. When <The Underworld> was destroyed, it was Kang Ilhun who inflated Cheon Inho's discord in the middle.

However, Kang Ilhun's fatal weakness was that he had almost no merit except for this [Rumor] ability.

Next, the Evil Ye Hyunwoo.

In the 40th Round, Ye Hyunwoo was called the 'Disappearing One'. The reason was simple.

"Where did that bastard Ye Hyunwoo go again?"

"It seems he made eye contact with Yoo Joonghyuk again."

It was because of his habit of disappearing at important moments. Ye Hyunwoo would disappear in an instant, no matter how dire the situation. He abandoned his colleagues, abandoned his friends. He was someone who could disappear at any time for his own survival.

That was the Evil Ye Hyunwoo.

"Lee Dansu-ssi."

"What?"

"Do you have a daughter?"

"No, I don't."

"I knew it."

"What was your intention behind asking this?"

'Ghost Slayer' Lee Dansu was explained last time, so let's skip it.

I looked at the old Kyung Sein one last time.

"What do you see? Surely you're not in love with me again, are you?"

Kyung Sein, who talks nonsense whenever she gets a chance, was called 'Strong-Weak-Weak-Strong' in the 40th Round. It's obvious what kind of person she is just by hearing her nickname, so I want to skip the explanation, but if I had to explain it anyway.

"Cheon Inho, you know that the one who fell in love is the 'weaker one', right?"

Kyung Sein was a villain who had trained the [Insect Massacre] story to the limit.

It would be helpful if weaker rascals than Kyung Sein appeared, but the problem is that the Constellations of the Giant Nebula are what we have to fight.

"Aren't there any more helpful Ten Evils? Why, Dokhee, Reinheit, Gong Pildu—"

Ye Hyunwoo, who had reappeared in response to my question, quirked his lips.

"Are you seriously asking?"

"Yes."

"They all died because of your scheme."

"What about the other Ten Evils?"

I thought of the Ten Evils that appeared in the main story. For example, Jo Jincheol of the Gyeonggi Alliance, Choi Hangyu, the explosive monster who rode in the same car as Yoo Joonghyuk, or even Kim Cheolyang, the Life Cult Leader of Geumho Station…

"Weren't they all killed on your orders?"

"On my orders?"

"You clearly said it yourself. The Ten Evils that have survived until now are the Ten Evils that are worth using."

Ten Evils that are worth using.

In other words, Jo Jincheol, Choi Hangyu, and Kim Yang were not worth using according to Cheon Inho's standards in the 40th Round.

They were either uncontrollable or there was some other reason. I sighed and continued.

"Just in case, are there any survivors among Yoo Joonghyuk's comrades?"

I ignored the Ten Evils who looked at me like I was crazy and continued to ask.

"If there's anyone whose head we can retrieve..."

"Oh, do you need a meat shield?"

"No, I didn't say that..."

"If that's what it's for, it's Lee Hyunsung. By the way, if I tell you how Lee Hyunsung died because of your scheme..."

"Yes, I understand, so that's all."

I hastily cut off his words. I was afraid that Yoo Joonghyuk might hear.

I realized anew. What did Cheon Inho do to Yoo Joonghyuk? And which character am I possessing?

I looked back at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was training his spear from afar, and thought. Is it really okay for Yoo Joonghyuk to be my comrade? Even if he has a memory loss, can he become comrades with the villain he once hated the most in the world?

「That's quite interesting.」

I suddenly slapped my cheek.

I don't know why, but ever since I entered this 'Time Fault', I've been having strange thoughts.

「I'm Cheon Inho.」

I'm not Cheon Inho. But I keep thinking like Cheon Inho and talking like Cheon Inho without realizing it. Maybe it's natural since I've possessed Cheon Inho from the 40th Round... but what should I say? It seems like it's getting a little too much.

"Cheon Inho."

Ye Hyunwoo called me in a serious voice.

"The King's condition is strange."

I stood up in surprise. Yoo Joonghyuk, who had clearly been practicing stabbing just a moment ago, had suddenly collapsed on the floor.

Lee Dansu stood up as if he knew it would happen and shouted.

"Finally, that's right!"

"As expected, you're the Evil Sophist. When did you spray it?"

"Is it time to rule the tyrant?"

I ignored the Ten Evils who were babbling nonsense and hurriedly checked Yoo Joonghyuk's condition. The moment I painfully turned over Yoo Joonghyuk's upper body, which had collapsed due to his poor physical strength, I heard a growling sound from somewhere. It wasn't coming from my stomach.

Yoo Joonghyuk was looking up at the sky with a pale face.

"Why did you make me possess a body like this?"

"That's your original body."

"I'm hungry."

I sighed. I was about to say that it was fortunate that he collapsed because he was hungry, but then,

"I see a strange message."

"What message is it?"

"It says that I will die if I don't eat food within an hour."

I quickly called out to the Ten Evils. After all, this was Geumho Station, and since it was their base from the beginning, I thought there might be food stockpiled.

But.

"There's nothing to eat?"

"That's right. <Olympus> and <Vedas> guys did it."

I heard that there was almost no food left for humans to eat in the Korean Peninsula. It was because the Giant Nebulae scattered the 「Earth Pollution」 story all over the planet in order to kill off the humans on the surface.

"Then what did you eat to survive?"

At my question, the Ten Evil looked at each other and answered with a grin.

"We are undead, so we don't need much food."

"You need less. So what did you eat?"

"Underground..."

"Oh, is there something underground?"

"We ate dirt."

I thought I heard wrong.

"What did you eat?"

"You were the one who [incited] us like that."

The Ten Evils seemed a little embarrassed that they had survived by eating dirt, so he made an excuse.

"Soil is nutritionally excellent food. All crops absorb the nutrients in the soil and—"

I hesitated for a moment before speaking to Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Do you want to eat nutritionally superior food?"

"No."

"Yes, I will serve you right away."

[Activate exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???'!]

"Yoo Joonghyuk, eat dirt."

The Ten Evils, shocked by my declaration, all looked at Yoo Joonghyuk. They all looked curious about when Yoo Joonghyuk would eat dirt.

[Your 'Incite' failed due to the effect of that character's special ability.]

What?

Yoo Joonghyuk spoke with his eyes glaring as if spitting blood.

"That kind of thing... I won't eat it even if I die."

I wanted to say that he's already eaten it several times, but that wasn't the important thing.

You're saying that the instigation isn't working?

"Then what are we going to do?"

"We have to cook."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who got up with my help, took out small kitchen utensils from his bosom. A small table, a cutting board, and even a kitchen knife. I wanted to ask why he was carrying those things in his coat, but it seemed stranger that Yoo Joonghyuk didn't have those tools when it came to the final scenario.

"Oh my god, I can see the king's cooking!"

In the meantime, the Ten Evils who were excited to see the king were exclaiming in admiration.

Yoo Joonghyuk ignored the onlookers and started cooking.

I asked him with a slightly fearful look, knowing Yoo Joonghyuk's new trait.

"What are you going to make?"

"Evil Spirit Yukhoe."

That was nonsense. How could you get Yukhoe from an Evil Spirit that didn't even have a body in the first place?

"I have the ingredients."

But there were the ingredients.

According to Yoo Joonghyuk's explanation, when a Transcendent that can use the sword cuts a soul body, there are cases where a cross-section of the soul body temporarily materializes.

I picked up a dark lump of meat and asked.

"So you're going to eat this?"

"If I sprinkle some seasoning and do a little bit of preparation…"

At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk's kitchen knife exploded in the air.

[The special characteristic of the corresponding incarnation is activated!]

[The corresponding incarnation cannot cook!]

"Bam! Supreme King! I knew it!"

"You were after us after all—"

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly sat down while watching the Ten Evils running away from the flying kitchen knife.

"Damn it."

It had been a long time since I saw Yoo Joonghyuk despairing.

I quickly raised him up and asked.

"What if I make it?"

"I don’t eat food made by others…"

Looking at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was on the verge of starvation, I also felt a faint sense of despair. I wondered if this situation made sense.

We had reached the Last Scenario. But the biggest obstacle blocking our path here was not the Constellations or the scenario, but 'food?'

I desperately thought of something Yoo Joonghyuk could eat. I thought about feeding him stories like before.

[The incarnation in question must consume 'food'.]

Stories were not considered 'food'.

In other words, in order to save Yoo Joonghyuk now, I had to somehow make a dish that he could eat.

However, this guy only eats the food he makes. In this situation, there was no way I could make food for him—

「No, wait a minute.」

I looked at Yoo Joonghyuk blankly, then naturally put my hand inside my coat. After a moment, I was holding a small piece of a recipe in my hand.

「There is. Food that Yoo Joonghyuk can eat.」

A light cheer came from inside the quiet library. I heard.

「"Would you be able to eat this?"」

Cheon Inho's voice floated over the daily newspaper in real time. The kkomas Kim Dokjas who confirmed that line shouted in unison.

Among them was the Demon King of Salvation — the Eldest Kim Dokja.

「(That's right! You should have done that a long time ago, Youngest!)」

It had been quite some time since he had entered the [Fourth Wall]. At first, the small library was quite stuffy, but as time passed and the fragments of Kim Dokja gathered, the library gradually grew in size.

The Eldest Kim Dokja took out a book from the corner of the library and returned to the newspaper.

『The Recipe for Murim Dumplings』.

The Youngest must be reading this diligently by now.

The Eldest Kim Dokja smiled happily as he thought of the Youngest who was diligently learning the recipe to make dumplings.

「(By the way… This Round won't be easy.)」

Although he had also visited the 1,863rd world line, the 'Time Fault' that the Youngest entered this time was a bit different.

Above all, the Youngest had to clear the 'Last Scenario' of the 40th Round in order to complete this 'Time Fault'.

「(Damn, is there any helpful information?)」

Although he couldn't contact the Youngest directly due to the 'Fear' penalty, the Eldest Kim Dokja would constantly take out books in the library and read them whenever he had time. He thought that he might find some information that would be helpful to the Youngest.

From the 'Ways of Survival' that he had read in the past to 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' written by Han Sooyoung.

And today, the Eldest Kim Dokja discovered a rather unusual bookshelf.

「(Was there a bookshelf like this?)」

A bookshelf that had been pushed aside by other bookshelves and had not been noticed until now. The moment he saw the titles of the books on the bookshelf, the Eldest Kim Dokja realized what kind of bookshelf it was.

『The Origin of Memory』.

All Kim Dokja have a bookshelf that contains their own history.

This bookshelf probably contains the Youngest's 'past'.

The Eldest Kim Dokja hesitated for a moment before taking out a book from the bookshelf. As expected, the bookshelf contained the Youngest's memories.

As if opening an old album, the Eldest Kim Dokja began to turn the pages with a faint smile.

However, every time he turned the page, Kim Dokja's expression hardened a little.

「(What is this?)」

Why is that?

「■■■.」

The Youngest's name was disappearing in real time from the book.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 844 Episode 45 Ten Evils (2)

One New Year, Giyeon once greeted me with these words.

—Listen carefully. The world has been destroyed.

Another new material.

I answered.

—Yes, it seems like your novel has already failed.

—No. I told you to listen carefully.

—It’s a story where I alone start with great powers in the apocalypse.

Giyeon was startled by my answer and asked.

—How did you know?

—How could I not know?

Now that I think about it, I could talk to Giyeon quite like Ji Eunyu.

—Wow, this time it’s really different.

Giyeon grumbled for a while before sending me the introduction he had written.

—Only I can cook in this world.

Unfortunately, Giyeon's introduction was never used. That's because Giyeon disappeared shortly after. I sometimes wonder what would have happened if Giyeon had continued writing that cooking novel.

Would that story have been born as a world in another dimension?

Oh, why am I telling you this?

"The One Who Deceived the Stars. How long are you going to keep reading the recipes? If you keep doing this, the King will die."

It's because I feel like I've become the main character of that story now.

I don't know why I have to go through the former route of the 'Murim Dumpling Chef' in the 40th Round, but unfortunately, there was a reader who wanted this story.

[The 'King of Fear' is paying attention to your actions.]

What on earth do you want to see, Kim Dokja? Do you really want to see a story about making Murim dumplings?

No. Rather than that, aren't you more curious about the story of Yoo Joonhyuk, who came back to life without eating dumplings, destroying all the Constellations in the 40th Round, and Cheon Inho, who waved his cheering stick diligently next to him?

[The 'King of Fear' is curious about the 'Murim Dumplings' you made.]

I sighed deeply and read the recipe. How much longer did I read like that?

A message came to my mind.

[Story fragment 'Murim Dumpling Recipe' resonates with you.]

It was the moment when the Youngest Kim Dokja finally changed his job to become a 'Murim Dumpling Chef'.

「My name is Manri Shintong Heo Poong. I don't know who you are, but I sincerely thank you for continuing the progress. This 'Murim Dumpling' is an authentic recipe I developed 1,200 years ago…」

Whether it was Heo Poong or Jang Poong, the progress of a great nobleman entered my head.

[NOTE 1]

I bowed in my mind to the invisible dumpling master and then looked at the culprit of this whole situation.

"I'm hungry."

There were now 10 minutes left. I had to make dumplings that Yoo Joonhyuk could eat within 10 minutes. The Ten Evils, who were watching me holding the cooking utensils, asked.

"But do you have the dumpling ingredients?"

"What are you going to do by just reading the recipe when you don't have the ingredients?"

"It's not too late. We have plenty of poison and curse traps."

The Ten Evils' point was right, but also wrong.

This 'Murim dumpling' is not an ordinary food. So the method of making it is not ordinary either.

「The key ingredient of 'Murim dumpling' is 'memory'.」

It is a food made with memory.

I concentrated for a moment and pulled out the fragments of the story from my memory.

"W-what did you do just now?"

"The dumpling skin suddenly appeared out of thin air!"

The dumpling skin was my old memory.

「Ji Eunyu said. "Author! Please make him regress this time! Make him regress! I said you have to make him regress here!"」

For now, I had no choice but to write this memory. If you think about clearing the scenario in the future, you can't use memories related to 'Ways of Survival' or 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' carelessly. Then,

「The only thing I can use now is the memory of 'Lee Hakhyun'.」

Make it like this, make it like that, then fill the inside of the memory as written in the recipe, cook it...

After a while, a steaming dumpling was completed.

[Congratulations! You've completed 'Authentic Murim Dumpling'!]

[Your cooking skill is very low!]

[Your Murim Dumpling completion level is as follows.]

Completion level: ★☆☆☆☆

Overall: A dumpling that you wonder if you can eat. The combination of memories is terrible. Beware of side effects.

Wow, isn't one star too much? No. Is one star normal for a beginner?

"Huh, how—"

"The Evil Sophist can really make dumplings..."

"These are dumplings that the devil would eat."

I ignored the Ten Evils and approached Yoo Joonhyuk.

Yoo Joonhyuk muttered while looking at me with a pale face.

"I… keug!"

I stuffed a dumpling into the guy's mouth so that he couldn't continue his words.

"Keuheuk."

It suddenly felt as if he was having a seizure and thought he was vomiting blood.

This went on for five minutes. Just as Lee Dansu was about to start raving about the poison, Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly muttered.

"Regression."

Regression?

"Regression right now…"

The Ten Evils ran towards Yoo Joonhyuk, who was strangling himself.

"The Supreme King is trying to commit suicide!"

"Stop it!"

It seems I had inserted a memory that shouldn’t have been inserted.

---

Yoo Joonhyuk recovered quickly.

The food he needed was three dumplings a day. Fortunately, there was no 'story of eating eight meals' because he was a zombie. Three was enough for me to suffer the memory loss penalty.

"You didn't put in any weird memories this time, did you?"

"Yes. Only happy memories."

"But why does that Ji Eunyu keep yelling at you? Is she your enemy?"

It's been three days since Yoo Joonhyuk started eating the dumplings I made. He always looked at me suspiciously, but now he's started eating my dumplings quite well.

The Ten Evils watching us looked confused.

"Damn it, some people are eating dirt, and some are eating dumplings."

"Are you discriminating against people right now?"

But I can't give the Ten Evils the dumplings I made with my memories.

[The proficiency of story fragment 'Murim Dumpling Recipe' increases!]

Huh?

[The incarnation that eats your 'Murim Dumpling' will receive the proficiency bonus effect of skills or stigma.]

I was surprised. No, 'Murim dumplings' have this effect? I hesitated for a moment and glanced at the Ten Evils.

Since it turned out like this, isn't there a way to raise the status of the Ten Evils by feeding them a lot of dumplings?

"Would you like some dumplings?"

As soon as I finished speaking, the Ten Evils all came running and snatched the dumplings from my hand.

"Delicious! Delicious! Damn it!"

"Is this how the tyrant lives? He's a happy guy!"

"I don't think he'd put any deadly poison in them..."

If I knew they'd like it this much, I should've made it for them a long time ago.

It was sad to see four people splitting one dumpling, so I tried to make another one, but Yoo Joonhyuk grabbed my shoulder.

"You, your hands are weird."

"Huh?"

Only after hearing Yoo Joonhyuk's words did I realize that my hands were shaking faintly.

Did I overdo it? I've been making too many dumplings lately.

"If you keep doing that, all your memories will disappear."

"Well, for now, I'll make them into unnecessary memories—"

"There are no unnecessary memories."

It was a bit unexpected that Yoo Joonhyuk said that, so I was speechless for a moment and focused on what he was saying.

"All memories are the foundation of existence. Every memory has its own role to maintain existence."

"That's true, but I don't think it's something someone who sacrificed their memories as a sacrifice for 'Story Imprint' should say."

"That's—"

"You're the one who ate the dumplings I made anyway, so if I forget something, I can just ask you."

Yoo Joonhyuk frowned.

"The dumplings weren't delicious enough to answer all those questions."

"Was it that bad?"

"I definitely knew you weren't Cheon Inho."

Well, since he's been eating dumplings made with my memories, Yoo Joonhyuk must have come to know a little about me now.

That I'm not Cheon Inho, and that I came from a different world line.

"Take care of your memories. You're a possessed being. If the possessor loses his or her memories, the spirit will eventually be consumed by the body."

I had never thought about it that way, but suddenly I felt a little scared.

If I forget all my memories from when I was Lee Hakhyun, what will I become?

"If that happens, please hit me hard on the back of the head."

"Okay."

"This time, you won't say no."

"I think it'd be good to finish this scenario soon."

"How are you going to finish it?"

"The goal of this scenario is 'to destroy the ark and reach the Final Wall'."

"So?"

Yoo Joonhyuk stood up from his seat with a look of 'what's the point of saying more?' and declared while looking at the Ten Evils, who were still picking up dumpling crumbs.

"We're going to attack the ark today."

---

And our attack failed spectacularly.

"Kuaaaaah!"

As soon as he set foot on the ark, 'Rumor Expert' Kang Ilhun's head was blown off again.

"Damn it! This bastard Ye Hyunwoo is already gone!"

'The one who disappears' Ye Hyunwoo disappeared in an instant.

"Me, a weaker guy than me, come out! Only weaker guys come out!"

There was no Constellation weaker than 'Strong-Weak-Weak-Strong' Kyung Sein.

"Trap set! Huh... Do these guys not even respond to poison!"

'Ghost Executor' Lee Dansu as committing the foolish act of spraying poison on the Constellations.

And yet we had Yoo Joonhyuk. No matter what anyone says, a tyrant is a tyrant. The Constellations were shocked.

And what happened?

"Make more dumplings."

I sighed deeply as I watched Yoo Joonhyuk lose one of his arms and legs.

Yoo Joonhyuk was silent for a long time and then said something I hadn't asked.

"This is the first time I've even gotten to the Final Scenario."

I laughed in vain.

Come to think of it, this kid, Yoo Joonhyuk, hadn't even gotten to the Final Scenario.

"Well, it wasn't bad for a first attempt."

Although he returned half-paralyzed, Yoo Joonhyuk's inaction was enough to alert the Constellations.

Yoo Joonhyuk, who had infiltrated the ark, killed over twenty Historical-grade Constellations and appeared in a half-body form. He achieved the feat of cutting off Ares's head.

To be honest, it was a great achievement up to that point. Even if Yoo Joonhyuk had been resurrected for the 40th time, I didn't expect him to show off that much power.

But the moment Zeus's incarnation was strong, we had no choice but to run away like Ye Hyunwoo.

Yoo Joonhyuk muttered as if his pride was hurt.

"Zeus is a top-tier Constellation even among myths. If I had a proper weapon, I could have fought him…"

"So you're saying that if you have a weapon, it's okay?"

"At least I can buy some time."

Unfortunately, the weapon that Yoo Joonhyuk currently has is a SS-grade item that is a replica of the sacred relic 'Bangcheonhwageuk'.

If he had the 'Cheongryongeonwoldo' or 'Triana', or even the original of the 'Bangcheonhwageuk', the situation would have been different.

"Procuring weapons isn't necessarily the only way."

"Then?"

"Then?"

"The goal of the scenario is to destroy the 'Ark' anyway. If we can access the 'Story Core', which is the core power source, we don't necessarily have to deal with the <Olympus> guys."

Then, 'The Disappearing One' Ye Hyunwoo appeared from somewhere and tackled him.

"The Story Core of the Ark is guarded by Mythical Constellations."

"Yes. It was really helpful that you showed up when we really needed it and told us those words."

"And we don't know the schematics for the power facility."

Even if it was said by someone I didn't like, it was true.

Anyway, our immediate tasks were reduced to two.

One, get a weapon for Yoo Joonhyuk.

Two, get a map to the power facility.

I was starting to get tired.

What would happen to us if we didn't clear the 40th Round?

[The 'King of Fear' is watching your choice.]

Still, it's fortunate that we can suppress the 'End' until the very end.

I let out a light sigh and asked the Ten Evils.

"Do you have any useful spears?"

No one answered.

I stared at the Ten Evils blankly and took out a dumpling.

"Does anyone have any useful spears?"

Judging from the fact that there was no response even after I gave them the dumplings, it seemed that there really were no useful spears.

Then Lee Dansu, who had been hesitating, stepped forward.

"We don't have any, but I know a guy with a good spear."

"Who is that?"

"I'll tell you if you give me a dumpling."

I lightly threw a dumpling at Lee Dansu. The Ten Evils screamed, "Damn, I should've told him!" as Lee Dansu took a bite of the dumpling.

I asked Lee Dansu, who happily took a bite of the dumpling.

"Now tell me."

"Blood Demon."

I had forgotten. There were other living incarnations in this world besides us. It seemed like it was time for that incarnation to be of help for the first time.

"What kind of spear does he have?"

"From the Blue Dragon Sword to the Heavenly Sword. I'm sure they have all the relics of a decent level."

I said, jumping up from my seat.

"Let's go and steal them right now."

We've already raided the Ark. Since Yoo Joonhyuk is on our side, there was no reason to be afraid of the Blood Demon.

But the expressions on the group's faces were not good.

"It'll be hard."

"Why?"

"Even if all of us go, we can't deal with the Blood Demon gang."

"We have Yoo Joonhyuk. Is Blood Demon the name of a Constellation that is on the same level as Zeus?"

Ye Hyunwoo looked at me pitifully and nodded at Yoo Joonhyuk.

"You, don't you know about the traits of the Supreme King?"

"Trait? What trait?"

"The Supreme King's combat power decreases to less than a tenth when fighting against an incarnation."

I quickly used [Character List] to check Yoo Joonhyuk's status.

As expected of the 40th Round, Yoo Joonhyuk possessed a number of impressive traits. From 'Ruler of Amusement' to 'Iron-Blooded Supreme King'.

Some of the traits were comparable to those of the 1,863rd Round.

However, there was one strange one among them.

> Trait: Curse of the Stars.
>
> The target's rank increases by two when fighting a Constellation. However, when fighting against any kind of 'Humanoid Incarnation', the rank decreases to a tenth.

"Why did you learn this trait?"

"Yoo Joonhyuk didn't learn it."

"Then?"

"It's a trait that came about because of the curse trap you set at the end. Did you forget this too? The reason you were able to defeat the Supreme King is because—"

"Yes, I understand."

What the hell did you do, Cheon Inho?

So the most important force right now is useless in the Blood Demon War.

"Let's make a deal with the Blood Demon."

"You know what he wants, right? Are you willing to offer the Supreme King's head?"

"That would be difficult."

"That's all he wants."

What he wants.

A sudden thought occurred to me.

"You said there's nothing to eat outside right now, right?"

"I did."

I muttered, looking down at the Murim dumplings in my hand.

"Then what does he eat to live?"

Only I can cook in this world.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Image of the Murim Dumpling Master Chief from The World After the Fall (It is another work of the author Sing N Song, which they introduced in ORV) Thie is the Chief who invented Murim Dumplings

# 845 Episode 45 Ten Evils (3)

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I thought about Giyeon hyung all the way to the Blood Demon's base.

Giyeon hyung, who Cheon Inho took and disappeared into the mirror. Maybe Giyeon hyung is watching my story with Cheon Inho right now.

That would be nice.

Because Giyeon hyung's imagination, who likes Giyeon, might bring Giyeon to me.

I desperately needed Giyeon right now.

[NOTE 1]

[The owner of the Time Fault is watching your story.]

This 'Time Fault' is the 'Last Scenario' that Cheon Inho experienced.

I guess the 'Time Fault' that the Recorders of Fear had was related to their 'core scenario 0'. Just looking at the fact that Bicheonhori, who was from Murim, had the Time Fault of the '0th Murim', it seems like that.

Then what did Cheon Inho want to see by making me experience this 'Time Fault'?

「Try writing 'again' from now on.」

He told me to 'write again'. That means, he didn't like the events of the 'Time Fault' he lived through.

[If you solve the 'Time Fault' task, you can read the 'Final Chapter' of the ■■-level Fear 'Evil Sophist'.]

The final chapter of the 'Evil Sophist'.

If I somehow get to see the ending of this Fault, it means I can also see the history of the 'Original 40th Round' that Cheon Inho lived through.

Suddenly, I wonder.

How on earth did Cheon Inho clear the Final Scenario?

No, did he clear it?

The guy probably didn't even have the revived Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Look straight ahead."

Yoo Joonghyuk caught me when I almost tripped on a rock.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at me as if I was pitiful and added.

"That's what the teacher said. A guy who can't even see the trees in front of him doesn't have the right to imagine the forest."

"That's true, but you still have to imagine the forest to understand the meaning of the tree in front of you."

Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the Ten Evils walking away from me and asked.

"Why did you come into this 'Time Fault'?"

"To prevent the End."

"Is that all?"

"I also have to meet the King of Fear."

"The King of Fear? Are you talking about the master of the Fear Realm?"

I briefly thought about whether I should tell Yoo Joonghyuk about the 'Second Kim Dokja'. However, I didn't know where to start, so I just nodded and left it at that.

"Yes, well. I also have to become stronger than I am now."

Yoo Joonghyuk and I both realized this as we escaped the 'Recycling Center'. We were receiving too much attention compared to our strength, and our enemies were stronger than we thought.

"We can't just become a little stronger. We have to become overwhelmingly stronger."

There was a strange tension in Yoo Joonghyuk's voice.

Yoo Joonghyuk's pupils deepened.

Somehow I felt like I knew who the guy was thinking of.

Of course. It must have been the first time he encountered such a strong 'existence' during his 41st Regression Turn.

"That guy said. The Time Fault is my only hope right now. If I don't reach proper 'Transcendence' here, it will be difficult to see the ending I want."

When did Jaehwan-nim say that? Did the two of them have a conversation?

"Aren't you already a 'Transcendent'? What is 'Proper Transcendence'?"

"I don't know either."

Yoo Joonghyuk muttered in a dark voice.

"But judging by the way he stabs, there must be such a state. And..."

"You believe that you can find the clue in this 'Time Fault'."

"That's right."

We walked for a short while in silence. Suddenly, a curiosity arose.

"Have you met Cheon Inho like me?"

This 'Time Fault' is a place that only those who have met the Recorder can enter. That means that Yoo Joonghyuk could have met Cheon Inho, who had become the Recorder of Fear.

"I met him."

As expected.

"What did he say?"

"He said to see for myself."

"What?"

Yoo Joonghyuk stopped walking.

"The end of the world I abandoned and left behind."

A faint light shone through the underground tunnel, and we had finally arrived at our destination.

Ye Hyunwoo, who had gone out to scout earlier, returned and reported the situation.

"That's the Blood Demon's base."

"Is it Seoul Station?"

The Blood Demon's base was underground in Seoul Station. It had been a long time since I visited the Seoul Station platform.

The memories of the 41st Round came to mind. In the 41st Round, the ruler of the Beggar Sect had taken over Seoul Station.

But this time, it was the Blood Demon.

"They've made a pretty strategic location their home."

I also nodded at Yoo Joonghyuk's words.

Considering the serious level of pollution on the surface, the Blood Demon's dwelling place had to be underground.

Of these, the station in the center of Seoul and where the lines overlap would be overwhelmingly advantageous for transporting goods.

"Damn, how many corpses did they make…"

In short, this 'underground passage' was a perfect place for the Blood Demon to transport the 'corpses' that he would use for surveillance production.

"Just by glancing at it, there are at least a hundred."

I quickly looked at the group of guards wandering around Seoul Station’s underground. It didn’t look like corpses made with [Deceased Summoning].

They were corpses without souls, moving only with the memories of their previous bodies.

I thought I knew the general principle of their revival.

「The Tale of David, who was ranked 3rd in the Darkness Ranking, 'King of the Dead'.」

It seems that the Blood Demon obtained the 'King of the Dead' in the 'Dark Castle' scenario of the 40th Round.

But it seems difficult to deal with all those undead.

"Is it finally time for this body to step forward?"

Kyung Sein straightened her small shoulders and stepped forward.

"Most of the surveillance is 'lower' than me. With my [Insect Massacre]..."

"Not all of them are lower than you, right?"

"Well, I see a few surveillance that are about the same level as me..."

"How many exactly?"

"...Twenty?"

I found the undead that Kyung Sein mentioned without much difficulty.

There were some that looked like they were of the higher species at first glance. Unlike the lower-level guards who were stupidly going back and forth between platform sections and repeating stereotyped actions, the upper-level guards were acting out of turn, such as suddenly turning their heads or sniffing something.

Kyung Sein asked nervously.

"Should we rush in right away?"

"No, wait."

"Oh, set a trap?"

"We're not here to fight."

I said, laying out the cooking utensils that Yoo Joonghyuk had in the center of the subway.

"Kyung Sein-ssi, you'll only come out if there's an emergency."

"Ahem, it's like a secret weapon, right?"

"Similar. So until an emergency arises, let's proceed according to my plan."

"Surely your plan isn't making dumplings again, right?"

Kyung Sein scolded me, as if she was not satisfied with my plan.

"The One Who Deceived the Stars. Are you serious? In fact, your condition has been a bit strange for the past few days."

"No matter how delicious the dumplings are, do you really believe that you can trade with the Blood Demon for something like dumplings?"

Ye Hyunwoo also chimed in.

I shrugged and answered.

"Even guards eat food, you know?"

"That's true, but—"

"Most of the high-level guards seem to be from 'Murim'."

"Some of them tried to take the dead Transcendents as their own corpses."

Transcendents. That's better.

"The ones who were resurrected through the story of the 「King of the Dead」 are in a state close to psychic beings without reason. Especially the more powerful the incarnation, the more simple and strong their desires are."

"So?"

"What food do the dead Murim martial artists want to eat the most?"

Lee Dansu answered my question with admiration.

"So it's 'dumplings', of course you'll put poison in them?"

"No. The guards won't be affected by even the most lethal poison. Instead, I'll put something as deadly as poison in them."

I didn't tell them what it was. Then I started making dumplings in front of everyone.

I made a total of thirty dumplings. It was a quantity that took extra into account.

[Your understanding of the story fragment 'Murim Dumpling Recipe' is quite high!]

[The average completion level of 'Murim Dumpling' increases!]

In the meantime, the skill level of the recipe has also increased a lot.

"You. Is it okay to make this much at once?"

"It's okay."

Because I didn't use my memories this time.

[The Master of the Time Fault looks at you in admiration.]

It seems that Cheon Inho noticed.

The memories I used when I made the dumplings this time were those of 'Cheon Inho of the 40th Round' that resided in this body.

It would be difficult if I used all of 'Lee Hakhyun's' memories.

"I will now give you the operation order."

I looked at the revived Kang Ilhun, Lee Dansu, Kyung Sein, and Ye Hyunwoo, and then asked.

"Lee Dansu-ssi is an expert at setting traps, right?"

"Just say it, I'll set it up anywhere."

"Yes. But what you're going to install this time is a little different."

I said, pointing to the table where the dumplings were.

"Please install this in the center of Seoul Station."

Lee Dansu looked down at the counter as if he had misheard, and asked me back.

"Installing it is not a problem, but it is quite bulky to place quietly."

"Ye Hyunwoo-ssi."

I said, pressing Ye Hyunwoo's shoulder as he quickly tried to disappear.

"Please support Lee Dansu-ssi with your [Erase Existence]."

"How did you know my skill name?"

I don't know. In the Last Scenario, the only thing that would allow that level of stealth is [Erase Existence], unless it was 「Pebble and Me」.

And [Erase Existence] was the ultimate stealth skill that could temporarily hide the presence of two people, including the caster, from the world.

"And lastly, Kang Ilhun-ssi."

"I won't be used as a meat shield anymore."

It was the words of a man who had already lost his head twice since I entered this Fault.

Of course, this time, it wasn't a meat shield that he was going to be.

"Spread the rumor in the <Star Stream> that the 'Head of the Regressor' has appeared at Seoul Station."

---

Three hours later, the Blood Demon appeared on the platform in Seoul, shouting a plaintive rebuke.

"How dare you!"

The entire platform smelled of fried dumplings.

I sat cross-legged on the table and waved to the Blood Demon.

"Are you here?"

The Blood Demon couldn't help but be astonished at the sight of his skeletons scattered everywhere. No wonder, because all twenty of his precious elite guards were sitting there.

Some skeletons shed tears of sorrow, while others snickered.

They were laughing. Deeply curled up corpses, wailing corpses…The Blood Demon who examined all of them asked.

"What on earth did you do to my corpses?"

"I just made them all a little drunk on perfume."

As expected, the corpses immediately took the bait on the table.

For reference, the dumplings that the corpses who were all from Murim ate were as follows.

「Chicken Soup Flavored Murim Dumplings」

「Dongpa Pork Flavored Murim Dumplings」

「Five-Spice Pork Flavored Murim Dumplings」

So-called 'Murim Specials'.

Completion: ★★☆☆☆

Overall: Made with low-quality memories, but the combination is not bad. The incarnation who eats these dumplings becomes immersed in the memories of the 'most missed food' they have ever eaten.

* When consumed, the abnormal 'Perfume' effect is activated for 30 minutes.

At least for the next 30 minutes, the zombies who were drunk on that taste wouldn't make any moves.

"Heh, heh heh heh."

The Blood Demon let out a hollow laugh, seemingly dumbfounded.

"You, do you really want to die? Do you think you've defeated me just because you've barely subdued these guys?"

"No. This won't be enough to defeat you."

I took a closer look at the Blood Demon's face again. Was that really the face of the incarnation that survived the Final Scenario with me?

Actually, I don't know much about the Blood Demon. In the main story, the Blood Demon is only described as a vile villain who killed the Breaking the Sky Sword Master together with the Heavenly Demon.

So before coming here, I looked through all of Cheon Inho's memories related to him.

And I found out that this guy was a bigger shot than I thought.

"The zombies in this underground city aren't even as big as the zombies you have."

「The Blood Demon. The Sing of the Seoul Underground City.」

In this 40th Round, he has thousands of 'watchmen' in the underground passages all over Seoul.

The second villain to rise to the top of the Ten Evils after Cheon Inho.

At this point, I'm starting to think that the Ten Evils are the main characters in this Round.

"Dumplings are for free. They're only like that for now, but when they all wake up, they'll all be stronger?"

"Stronger?"

The Blood Demon, who actually checked the status of the zombies, looked up at me with wide eyes.

"What are you doing here, you idiot?"

"Blood Demon. Are you still curious about the 'Regression Law'?"

I knew why the blood demon was so obsessed with the 'Regression Law'.

The blood demon grinned and asked back.

"Are you finally thinking of offering the head of the tyrant?"

"It's unfortunate, but even if you take the head of the tyrant, you won't be able to regress."

"How do you know that?"

"That's just how this world is set up."

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'.]

[Someone has confirmed that what you said is true.]

As expected, [Lie Detection] was on.

The confused Blood Demon asked.

"What the hell are you talking about?"

"It means that a small villain like you can never become the main character even if you wake up after dying."

I looked at the Blood Demon for a moment.

In fact, I don't like giving a small villain a story. After all, this guy was a villain who caused pain to many people, and even the incarnations suffered from him even after death.

「But even a small villain like that could take up a page of a chapter in a world without a main character.」

Nevertheless, some stories shed light on the hidden story of a horrible murderer rather than the last meal of a petty bourgeois who starved to death.

['The King of Fear' focuses on your story.]

And so the story of the Blood Demon came to exist in this Star Stream.

And I, the 'Evil Sophist'—

"Blood Demon. Do you want to meet your dead sister again?"

In this terrible world, I am a human who makes the 'story' of that villain a spectacle.

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

Note [1]: Giyeon; means conincidence in Korean.

# 846 Episode 45 Ten Evils (4)

"You... how do you know that?"

The Blood Demon glared at me with eyes mixed with confusion and anger.

If possible, I wanted to avoid doing something like this. But this time, I couldn't help it. Because.

「I already knew the ending of the Blood Demon.」

I looked closely at the Blood Demon's face. The appearance of a middle-aged man stained with time. However, the Blood Demon was very young when the scenarios were just beginning.

[Story fragment, 'The Little Sister of a Common Tragedy', begins its storytelling.]

「"Hahaha! Cheonah! What is your dream?"」

And his younger sister was even younger than that.

「"The strongest in the martial arts world! The best of the new world!"」

The Blood Demon's younger sister , Yeom Cheonah, who shouted with enthusiasm, was there.

And in the next moment, the voice changed and the Blood Demon Yeom Baekho's howl echoed. 「"Cheonah! No! Cheonah…!"」

[Story fragment, 'The Little Sister of the Common Tragedy', stops talking.]

Listening to the voice of the story flowing out, I once again felt goosebumps at the 'Evil Sophist'.

"How, how do you have that story?"

Cheon Inho in the 40th Round may have already considered that the Blood Demon would become the King of the Seoul Underground City.

That's why he had this 'story fragment'.

"Does that matter?"

I stared at the staggering Blood Demon, smiling like Cheon Inho.

Maybe the Blood Demon resembled Yoo Joonghyuk.

He was not as strong as Yoo Joonghyuk, was not born with any special abilities, and did not have a single reader who liked his stories. Nevertheless, he resembled Yoo Joonghyuk.

That was because he had not saved his sister even once in countless Rounds.

"Do you have Cheonah's soul?"

The Blood Demon came up to me like a madman and grabbed me by the collar.

"Tell me. Do you have Cheonah's soul?"

"What would change if I had her soul?"

The Blood Demon's movements that were shaking me stopped for a moment.

"Are you going to revive her? You know what you did, and now you're going to revive her? Do you think she'd like it if she came back to life?"

"What do you know..."

"Even if she comes back, you won't be forgiven. Because she told me."

Blood Demon Yeom Baekho.

Forty years ago, when the 'First Scenario' first began before his eyes, he was locked in a room alone with his younger sister.

"I hate you more than anyone else in this world."

A scenario where he had to prove his worth, prove through violence that he was more noble and superior to other living beings.

The Blood Demon proved it and survived alone.

"I, I, I—"

"I know why you want to find the Great Law of Regression. But, you know, Yeom Baekho."

Like Kim Dokja once did, some beings spend the rest of their lives in atonement for their survival. In the process, some sacrifice themselves, but others cannot endure the pain and choose to become worse people.

"Do you think everything will be as it was if you regress?"

To erase his original sin. To turn back everything he did to survive.

That was why the Blood Demon wanted Yoo Joonghyuk's 'regression' so much.

The Blood Demon's grip on my collar tightened with a firm grip.

"You're trying to deceive me with strange words again, you Evil Sophist. I won't say much. Give me the head of the Supreme King right now. Of course, you'll die even if you give it to me."

"Why? Because I know your secret?"

I laughed.

"Even if I could return with the head of the Supreme King, you wouldn't be able to change any of your pasts."

"How would you know that?"

"Even if you return, the memories of killing your younger sister won't disappear."

In the end, Yoo Joonghyuk's dilemma applies to all regressors.

The world he abandoned and left behind will forever be Yoo Joonghyuk's shackles.

However, the Blood Demon was crazier than I thought.

"Really? Then you should erase my memories as well."

The Blood Demon continued to babble in a voice dripping with gloomy madness.

"If you turn back the world and erase my memories, it will all be like nothing happened. Neither that child nor I will remember what happened this time. The things that no one remembers are like nothing. Then...!"

"If that's 'regression', then you've already regressed dozens of times."

"What?"

"You've already regressed. Which world do you think this world is?"

In a sense, the regressor in this world is not the only one. In this world, there exist countless regressors who 'don’t know that they have regressed'.

"You have already regressed forty-one times, and you have repeated the same choice for the forty-second time."

Not all humans who have lost their memories always make the same choice in the same situation. Rather, because they do not remember their past lives, their choices are pure and perhaps infinitely heavy.

The forty-two choices that they do not remember themselves. Those choices are what proves the Blood Demon.

[NOTE 1]

The Blood Demon has never died in place of his sister.

"That cannot be, that cannot be. I…!"

The Blood Demon staggered and let go of my collar.

I asked, adjusting the collar of my shirt.

"Are you that desperate about regressing? Is what you really want 'regression'? What you want is…"

Some desires do not exist until they are written down.

That is why sometimes the role of the writer is to accurately describe the desires that even the characters themselves ignore.

In that sense, the existence of the writer.

[Exclusive skill 'Incite Lv.???' activates!]

It may be a kind of incite that grants desire to the character.

"You will be forgiven by your sister."

The Blood Demon opened his eyes wide as if he had been struck by lightning.

Even though he knew that this was a trap I had set, he could not escape this trap.

His history made him that way.

"...How can I be forgiven by her?"

"..."

"I know you can use [Deceased Summoning]. Can you summon her? Let me meet her and talk to her one more time."

"What can you give me?"

"I will give you what you want. Anything you want!"

The conversation soon reached the point I wanted. The Blood Demon, who was completely taken in by [Incite], would not even remember what he had said for a while.

"Unfortunately, I cannot summon your sister's soul. Because I cannot find your sister's 'head' anymore."

One of the conditions of [Deceased Summoning] is the summoner's 'head'. So, in the first scenario, Yeom Cheonah, the Blood Demon's younger sister, died with her head exploded, and no matter what he did, she could not be revived.

"And even if you meet her, you will not be forgiven anyway."

"Then what do you want me to do! If I cannot meet my younger sister, and even if I do, I will not be forgiven—"

"There is only one way."

I said with a grin.

"I will make you regress."

I suddenly held out the dumpling on the table.

"Eat this dumpling."

The Blood Demon glared at me with his lips pursed.

The Blood Demon must have noticed it too. The familiar yet strange smell coming from this dumpling.

After staring at the dumpling for a long time, the Blood Demon's expression softened and he let out a deep sigh.

"Is this a dumpling with poison?"

"It contains something more deadly than poison."

This dumpling was made with the memories of the Blood Demon's younger sister, 'Yeom Cheonah', that Cheon Inho obtained when he destroyed <The Underworld>.

"What happens if I eat this?"

"You can meet Yeom Cheonah. Of course, it's not the living Yeom Cheonah. It'll be hard to communicate properly."

"..."

"Even if you eat this, you won't be forgiven. Your life won't change."

"Then why should I eat this?"

"Face what you did to survive."

The Blood Demon looked down at the dumpling with trembling eyes.

"Eat this and go see your younger sister. Ask for an obvious, one-sided forgiveness that she'll never hear. And come back hurt by the fact that nothing has changed."

"You said you'd make me regress. How is that a regression?"

"That's a regression. Nothing can be changed."

The Blood Demon raised his head and looked at me.

"If one regression could change something, why did Yoo Joonghyuk need to regress so many times?"

The Blood Demon stared blankly for a moment, how he had taken my words unknown, before he soon let out a sneer. Then he snatched the dumpling from my hand.

"Evil Sophist. I already know what your purpose is."

"Yes. As you know, the moment you eat that, I…"

"I'll give you time until I wake up again."

I was a little taken aback by the Blood Demon's answer. He added, as if he found my expression amusing.

"If you're still in front of me when I wake up again, I'll make you a guard too."

With those words, the Blood Demon took a big bite of the dumpling in his hand. I could see his eyes dilating as the sweet scent spread.

Completion: ★★★☆☆

Overall: A dumpling made from someone's terrible nightmare. Anyone who eats this dumpling will experience the nightmare the memory holder had for 30 minutes.

The Blood Demon must have returned to the hellish First Scenario by now. The time limit for the First Scenario was 30 minutes. It matched the duration of the dumplings exactly.

He would meet his sister there once again.

"Is it over?"

I turned around at the voice from behind me, and Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been hiding in the darkness with the Ten Evils, appeared.

"It's over."

"You finally achieved your goal with just one tongue."

"Actually, this wasn't the best method."

I said, staring into space and looking at the frozen Blood Demon.

"I could have asked the Blood Demon for help."

It wasn't enough to just open the Blood Demon's wounds and inflict terrible trauma.

There was a reason I chose this method in the picture.

[Anonymous Recorder is watching your story.]

Because there were 'eyes' watching this story.

[Anonymous Recorder admires the way you handled the 'Blood Demon'.]

[Anonymous Recorders admire the way you deal with Fear.]

[Anonymous Recorders express favor to your story.]

Anonymous Recorder. Perhaps, like Bicheonhori or Cheon Inho, there were other 'Recorders of Fear' whose true names were not revealed.

It felt similar to when I was getting attention from Constellations, but somehow it felt subtly different.

If the Constellations were closer to 'readers', then these were closer to 'critics'. Anyway, the critics' attention was on me right now.

[A total of 9 anonymous Recorders' showed their favor to you.]

And their attention—

[You can convert the 'favor' of the Recorders into coins. Would you like to convert it?]

It was converted into a huge amount of coins and returned to me.

[You have earned 180,000 coins!]

It was a much-needed income for now. In order to clear the Last Scenario, I had to raise Cheon Inho's comprehensive ability, and there were things I had to buy from the 'Dokkaebi Bag'.

Kyung Sein, who was observing the frozen Blood Demon, asked.

"Wouldn't it be better to just kill him now?"

"The Blood Demon has achieved the ultimate of the legend of 'King of the Dead'. If I kill him, all the ghouls in the underground of Seoul will go berserk at the same time."

In the end, it was best to let the Blood Demon sleep for a while.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had made a quick decision, said.

"The Blood Demon’s warehouse is upstairs."

"Let’s move right away."

We went straight up the stairs of Seoul Station.

The Blood Demon’s corpses didn’t stop us even as we passed by. Perhaps they had received such an order.

"You."

After climbing the dimly lit stairs several times, Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth as if passing by.

"Do you really think that regression can’t change anything?"

It seemed like he had overheard my conversation with the Blood Demon.

I answered with a bitter smile.

"No. Actually, I think a little differently."

Perhaps regression itself can’t change anything.

The tragedy that has already happened is eternal, and no one can be saved through regression.

Even so, I know people who have changed through that 'regression'.

"Anyway, everything remains a story."

"What do you mean?"

"Even if nothing changes in the story, it means that the person reading the story may change."

Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to think about what I meant for a moment.

In the meantime, Ye Hyunwoo, who was walking ahead, stopped walking.

"We've arrived."

"There's a trap. I'll remove it."

Lee Dansu quickly stepped forward and dismantled the trap. After a while, the huge iron door opened with a creaking sound.

Is this really the Blood Demon's warehouse?

"As expected of the Blood Demon."

All the relics that could be found throughout the scenario were gathered there. From special relics like the Chochegeom and Cheonungeom to the 'useful spear' we were looking for.

Yoo Joonghyuk pulled out a spear from a corner and examined the spearhead.

"It's Guanyu's spear."

The Azure Dragon Crescent Blade. As expected, it was a weapon with great dignity, worthy of the relic of the best warrior in the Central Plains.

"Are you going to take it?"

"No."

Yoo Joonghyuk shook his head and looked somewhere.

"There’s a better spear."

"Is it a more useful spear than that?"

"It’s not useful."

Yoo Joonghyuk strode over and pulled out a spear stuck in the darkness. The moment the blade was pulled out, a dazzling beam of light illuminated the dark warehouse. I immediately recognized the spear.

Yoo Joonghyuk’s final spear—the material just before completing the Amcheon-wolguk.

A beautiful spear that seemed to have been carved from a deep sunset was there.

"This is the best spear for now!"

Hwangcheon-wolguk.

That spear was certainly a worthy replacement for the Cheongryongeonwoldo.

Moreover, in terms of durability comparable to the Jincheonpaedo, the Hwangcheon-wolguk was perfect for Yoo Joonghyuk to use now.

The Ten Evils who entered the warehouse together and rummaged through the items were busy exclaiming in admiration here and there. There was also a guy who couldn’t shake off his thieving instinct and was diligently stealing the sacred relics.

"I think the internal map of the 'Ark' might be here too."

"Well, if it's the Blood Demon guy, he should have it."

Ten minutes, twenty minutes. The Ten Evils and I continued to search the Blood Demon's warehouse, but unfortunately, we didn't find any items containing the information on the ark.

"This is a big deal. It's time— Huh? Cheon Inho. What are you doing there?"

I was looking at the feast of 'heads' decorated on the walls of the huge warehouse.

It seemed like the heads the Blood Demon had collected to make zombies.

"I don't think we need a map."

I said, looking at one of the heads.

"I found a better one."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Including 0th Round and 41st Round it makes 42 regressions.

# 847 Episode 45 Ten Evils (5)

A nicely stuffed head. The moment I saw her clean face that had been 'Preserved', I sighed.

"You were here, Kim Anna-ssi."

I originally didn't like Anna Croft that much. Maybe it was because I’m also a fragment of Kim Dokja, or maybe it was because I didn't feel attached to her while writing the main story. In any case, she was Yoo Joonghyuk's enemy.

However, while this 'side story' was going on, I got to see her a little bit again.

「Did you just say 'side story'?」

What am I thinking?

Anyway, the point I'm trying to make is that I don't hate Anna Croft that much anymore.

"Kim Anna?"

When Yoo Joonghyuk hardened his expression and expressed his doubts, I smiled and answered.

"Oh, I’m late to tell you. There's someone else who entered the 'Time Fault' besides you and me."

"No way..."

"That's why I think I should use [Deceased Summoning]. If I delay any longer, this guy might really become a Disaster-level Fear somewhere."

"Are you out of your mind? You brought that woman into the Fear Realm?"

As expected, Yoo Joonghyuk objected.

That would make sense. The guy was stabbed in the back by Anna, tortured, dragged around as a slave, and suffered many other terrible things.

But.

I often think about that these days.

If someone like Kim Anna did that to him... In fact, wasn't Yoo Joonghyuk too naive or stupid?

"You want to ask if I'm in my right mind. Are we being picky right now? Have you forgotten who our enemy is?"

"..."

"When you're receiving help from the Ten Evils, what difference would it make if you side with a Prophet who hit you in the back of the head?"

A faint sense of bewilderment crossed Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes.

"If we want to see the end in the 41st Round anyway, we have to join hands with Anna."

"..."

"We need her help. With her, we can explore the path ahead even without the map inside the ark."

If we could just use the Prophet's [Past Sight] and [Future Sight], the difficulty of the future scenarios would be twice as easy. Of course, even if it were twice as easy, the clear probability would only increase from 1% to 2%, but that's still an increase.

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me for a moment, then looked around with a fierce gaze.

"So you're saying that the woman's soul is somewhere here?"

"That's what I think."

Kim Anna is not stupid. If she can use [Future Sight], she would likely be using a special method like Yoo Joonghyuk to delay the possession.

"Are you going to take the Prophet's head?"

Common sense tells me that's right. [Deceased Summoning] takes thirty minutes, and the Blood Demon will wake up in about ten minutes. And he will come to this warehouse to make me a zombie.

Nevertheless, I persisted.

"No, I have to revive her here. If we hurry a little, it will be possible in twenty minutes."

"The Blood Demon will be here soon. It will be too late even if we leave with the head right now."

"Actually, it is already too late."

"What?"

I pointed to the entrance of the warehouse.

When did it start? The trap that Lee Dansu had released was reactivated, emitting a bright light. And it was much more powerful than before.

Lee Dansu groaned in surprise.

"Oh my. It's the Gimun Formation."

Gimun Formation. The secret technique used by the best martial artist in Joseon in the main story. It seemed that the Blood Demon, a martial artist, had laid a fairly classic trap to defend the warehouse.

"It was strange that the warehouse was opened so easily in the first place."

"Damn, no way."

"Did you think the Blood Demon would just hand over his treasures?"

Even if the Blood Demon lived to atone for his sister, his entire past is a past of evil.

He committed countless murders, piled up evil deeds, and repeatedly plundered in order to meet his sister again.

No matter how much you persuaded him, he would not just hand over the items he had collected with his eyes fixed on regressing.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was carefully examining the formation, said.

"We can break through it with force. However, it will take about twenty or thirty minutes to open. The formation level is quite high."

Then the Ten Evils stood up.

"If we strike together, wouldn't it be a little faster?"

"Everyone join in. We have to break it down right away."

"In a closed space, 'disappearing' is impossible—"

I said in a cheerful voice as I watched the Ten Evils tremble with anxiety.

"What are you all talking about? It's better. It means it's safer until that opens. Let's all rest comfortably here and start [Deceased Summoning]. Ye Hyunwoo-ssi, can you take out the Prophet's head?"

Then the Ten Evils looked at me as if I was crazy. Then, all of the Ten Evils' eyes turned to Yoo Joonghyuk. They looked as if they expected Yoo Joonghyuk to swing his spear and cut off my head at any moment. When Yoo Joonghyuk actually grabbed the spear of the Hwangcheon-wolguk, Kyung Sein gulped.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk stuck the spear in the ground and sat cross-legged on the floor.

"Revive Anna Croft."

A sigh escaped from the Ten Evils' mouths.

Yoo Joonghyuk's voice echoed in the warehouse that had become even more lonely.

"I will not dismantle the Gimun formation. It would be better to save my strength then open the door and deal with the guys coming down."

When Yoo Joonghyuk came out like that, the Ten Evils lost their momentum.

Well, it was the decision of the Supreme King, so who would dare to refuse?

Ye Hyunwoo reluctantly jumped into the air and came down with Anna's head.

"If everyone dies here, it's because of you."

"Aren't you all dead anyway except me?"

I received Anna's head.

The head was surprisingly well preserved, so there would be no problem performing [Deceased Summoning] right away.

"Hmm, is there a body that she can connect to?"

It seemed that the Blood Demon also knew Anna Croft's worth, as her body was also completely preserved.

Maybe he was thinking of making me an undead and using [Deceased Summoning] on Anna.

"Now, it's time to get up. Miss Kim Anna."

A moment later, a faint light appeared from Anna Croft's entire body, where her neck and torso were connected.

Yoo Joonghyuk muttered while watching the scene.

"Why do you call the Prophet by that name?"

"Isn't it friendly and nice?"

"It's better to keep your distance from the Prophet."

"Is that a lesson learned from your regressions?"

"…"

"You seem to believe that people don't change."

Yoo Joonghyuk's core values were all formed in his 'early regressions'. The principle that some should be accepted as colleagues and some should not be.

In fact, Yoo Joonghyuk's core colleagues barely changed during his thousand-plus regressions in 'Ways of Survival'.

"But if you're sure that nothing changes, your regressions would be meaningless."

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned.

"If you have time to talk nonsense, it would be better to shorten the summoning time by even one minute."

"Yes. There are 15 minutes left."

"What are we going to do after the Prophet wakes up?"

"We should escape together."

"By then, we would have already been surrounded by the Blood Demon's subordinates. No matter how great the Prophet's abilities are, it would be difficult to find a way out of the closed room. Her [Future Sight] is a much more effective skill in open spaces."

I was a little surprised because I didn't know Yoo Joonghyuk would say such an accurate thing.

Wasn't he foolish enough to get taken advantage of by Kim Anna?

Then, was Yoo Joonghyuk really naive?

"You're right. But the Blood Demon won't be able to get down here in time. Seoul Station would have become a battlefield by now."

As soon as my question fell, a loud thud echoed. A loud noise echoed from the upper and lower floors at the same time.

Kang Ilhun jumped up from his seat.

"This."

Just before he came here, Kang Ilhun spread a 'rumor' at my command.

"Evil Sophist, did you really expect this?"

Another thud. There was a sound of something being torn and an eerie crash.

The Ten Evils rose from their seats one by one and grabbed their weapons.

An eerie current felt beyond the iron gate.

Everyone here could feel it. A powerful and distant force felt even beyond that Gimun formation.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was holding onto the spear of the Hwangcheon-wolguk, growled.

"The Constellations have come."

---

The Blood Demon, who had woken up, touched his face. His cheeks were damp. He could no longer remember when he had last felt this way.

「"Cheonah."」

The 30 minutes were short. It was a fleeting dream. A dream with a predetermined ending. In that dream, instead of existing as the Blood Demon, he became the younger version of Yeom Baekho.

Yeom Baekho, who was carrying out the First Scenario. Yeom Baekho, who was conflicted about his younger sister in front of him.

Cheon Inho's dumplings reenacted that moment of 'choice' for him once again.

「"I'm sorry."」

This time, he wanted to show that he could make a different choice. Even if all of this was an illusion, he wanted to prove that he was a human being who could make a different choice.

He wanted to say that the Ten Evils weren't the Ten Evils from the beginning. Cheon Inho's words were wrong.

However, what he actually said in the dream was just a plain apology, just as Cheon Inho had expected.

「"I'm really sorry."」

It was a story with a predetermined ending. Crying was useless. The items he had desperately collected and the skills he had trained didn't work in the dream.

In it, he was just a helpless child. A kid who had to kill his younger sister to live.

「"Ughh..."」

Wasn't it his own despicable self-hypnosis that had fallen for the sophistry of the Evil Sophist?

「"My dream will come true for you, oppa."」

That was the end of the dream.

As Cheon Inho had said, he was not forgiven, and perhaps he would never be forgiven.

And all that was left for him was the sweet scent of dumplings lingering on the tip of his nose.

"You damn bastard."

The Blood Demon slowly got up from his seat. The promised 30 minutes had passed. Now it was time to go kill that bastard.

But.

Kukukukukuku.

There were those who had attacked his Seoul Station.

A colorful feast of ranks appeared beyond the collapsed ceiling.

[The Constellation 'Justice and Wisdom’s Spokesman' descends!]

A presence that makes even the weak kneel just with the appearance message.

One of the 12 gods of <Olympus>.

Athena, the successor of Zeus, was there.

That wasn't all.

[The Constellation 'Almighty Sun' descends!]

[The Constellation 'Hunter of Pure Moonlight' descends!]

[The Constellation 'God of Wine and Ecstasy' descends!]

Apollo, Artemis, and even Dionysus. Four of the 12 gods of <Olympus> descended.

Athena spoke in a voice filled with a sense of oppression that no living being dared to open their mouths.

[I heard that the head of the Regressor is here.]

The Blood Demon gritted his teeth and answered.

"Where did you hear such a rumor?"

It seemed that he had a rough idea of how the situation was going. That damned Sophist was up to something else.

[It doesn't seem like a rumor. I can definitely sense the aura of the Supreme King here.]

"…"

[You haven't forgotten your contract with us, have you?]

A brilliant light spread across Athena's body. The radiance of justice that punishes all evildoers.

The Blood Demon's face darkened.

[Open the warehouse.]

Four of the twelve gods of <Olympus> had come, so even the leader of Murim, not just the Blood Demon, had to open the door.

But instead of opening the door, the Blood Demon glared at the hole in the ceiling.

"Kuhaha, kuahahaha…!"

And went wild.

Before Athena could even open her mouth, the Blood Demon asked in a maddened voice.

"Contract? You mean the contract where I collect the leftovers you eat? Yes. If that's a contract, then it's a contract."

[…]

"You broke the contract first. Have you forgotten your 'promise not to enter the underground?'"

[This is an exception—]

"An exception. Then I will treat this as an 'exception' this time."

[Foolish villain. If you keep playing with your tongue recklessly—]

A strange current began to surge through the Blood Demon's body.

He knew well the power of the narrative-grade Constellations. However, he had not come to the 'Final Scenario' simply by luck.

"Damn Constellations."

He would not have done this under normal circumstances.

He knew that this was a clever trap set by the damned Evil Sophist.

Even so, the Blood Demon could not suppress the emotions that were suddenly welling up.

Perhaps this anger was caused by meeting his dead sister.

「My sister's dream was to become the new supreme being.」

What has he become now that he has inherited that dream? Slowly opening his eyes, the Blood Demon's eyes were filled with deep, pitch-black darkness.

"Do you know why the world calls me the 'King of the Underground City'?"

Although he had never directly confronted a Giant Nebula, the Blood Demon had also been building up his strength to deal with the Constellations. After dismantling the dying Constellations and studying them, he reached a single understanding.

That was that the Constellations could not be defeated in that night sky.

That understanding soon became his story.

[The Fable, 'Darkness that Eats Starlight', begins its storytelling.]

The darkness flowing from the Blood Demon spread like ink and filled the area in an instant. In the thick darkness, the power that the Constellations were emitting began to rapidly decline. Athena screamed in confusion.

[What—]

And after a while.

The skeletons who had bowed their heads in front of the Constellations began to rise one by one and open their bright yellow eyes. Dozens, hundreds, thousands of eyes glared at the Constellations in the darkness.

"At least the most dignified beings in this underground city."

Beings who were thrown into the scenario by the Constellations' play and died miserably. Those who hated the Constellations more than anyone else—the deceaseds who returned from beyond death.

The King of the Deceaseds, who held his sword at the front of them, smiled and said.

"It's not a Constellation."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 848 Episode 45 Ten Evils (6)

【The anonymous Recorders have started reading the Time Fault of the Evil Sophist.】

【...】

【Asmodeus?】

【Ah, I'm sorry, Bicheonhori. This is the first time I've seen a Round with such a strong Blood Demon.】

【It must be because Kim Dokja intervened. Even so, this story can't be considered official history.】

【Official history. Do you think that story is just unofficial history?】

【Yes. It's just a game to satisfy one Recorder.】

Asmodeus laughed at Bicheonhori's words.

【You're talking like you're not a Recorder.】

【...】

【Didn't you say that? The Anonymous Recorders have started reading the Time Fault.】

Asmodeus's teeth glowed white in the darkness.

【If more Recorders like that record, that record could become the official history.】

Asmodeus muttered as he gazed into the distant abyss.

【I wonder what the King of Fear thinks.】

---

A legend flowed from the pitch-black darkness.

The ghouls who didn't know how to scream rushed in. Athena's shield emitted light, and Artemis' arrows traced a trajectory. Apollo's heat burned the ghouls, and Dionysus, drunk, tore the flesh of the deceaseds.

Still, the ghouls were not afraid. As many ghouls fell to the Constellations' attacks, more ghouls were added.

Athena muttered as if she was fed up.

[I'm sick of it.]

Five minutes, ten minutes, fifteen minutes.

As time passed, the Constellations also began to take a hit little by little. The wounds on the limbs of the Constellations gradually increased due to the incarnations who did not fear death. It was possible because there was a 'Giant legend' that suppressed the Constellations' power.

[Giant legend 'Starlight-Eating Darkness' continues its storytelling.]

Tsutsutsut!

Blood flowed ceaselessly from the Blood Demon that drew on excessive probability. A lump of story spilled onto the floor.

Die. You damned Constellations.

The Blood Demon was laughing even as he felt his stories shatter into pieces.

He thought that he just needed to do a little more. Even if there were Narrative-grade Constellations, or even if they were the 12 great gods of Olympus, they couldn't defeat him here underground.

Greed flashed through the Blood Demon's eyes as he watched the Constellations gradually becoming more and more vulnerable.

What if he could get his hands on their incarnations? If only he could turn them into zombies.

[What a shame.]

With Athena's admiration, the pure white relic created a semicircular flash barrier centered on the four Constellations.

[Absolute Defense Zone.]

'Immortal Zone' that lasts for 10 seconds.

It was the ability of Athena's relic 'Aegis'.

The Blood Demon laughed.

"Are you trying to stall for time? It's useless."

He had been through more than half of Seoul Station, but if he pushed on like this, he would be the one who would win anyway.

"I will kill you guys and take your bodies. Then I will break through the Last Scenario. I will destroy the ark and go over the 'Final Wall'. So, I will make a wish at the end of that scenario."

The Blood Demon thought.

There is no need to regress anymore. His wish will come true in this Round.

"I will meet my sister once again—"

Blood spurted from the Blood Demon's right chest. His body shook and rolled around on the floor. His heavy breathing was mixed with blood.

Dududududu!

Bullets flying from somewhere were indiscriminately firing at the undead guarding him.

He thought that it couldn't be possible as he watched the ranks of undead collapsing. His undead couldn't be defeated by a mere bullet. Because the 'incarnation' who could do

such a thing had already died a long time ago.

That's why when that being appeared at the end of the battlefield, the Blood Demon could only mutter stupidly.

"Armed Fortress Lord?"

The Armed Fortress that approached from behind the Constellations, crushing the station.

He couldn't believe it. The once Third Evil, the Armed Fortress Lord Gong Pildu, had been killed by Cheon Inho. So what on earth was he seeing now?

"What the heck."

It wasn't just Gong Pildu.

There were figures walking towards Gong Pildu.

"Steel Sword Emperor… Maritime Admiral… Even the Delusion Demon? How—"

He couldn't believe it.

The dead tyrant's companions were there.

[The Constellation, 'One Who Stabbed His Own Eye', descends on Earth!]

Athena was indignant.

[You're late, Oedipus.]

[I'm sorry.]

Oedipus, his eyes shining brightly, looked at the Blood Demon in the darkness. Then, a voice with a terrible laugh flowed out.

[Why are you so surprised? Do you think we didn't know about your abilities? Your grand legends are of no use against the 'incarnations'. That's why we brought these guys here specially.]

"That can't be."

[What are you denying, you foolish villain.]

"I saw it clearly. The Armed Fortress Master! The Steel Sword Lord! The Maritime Admiral! I saw them all die clearly. But how..."

[Do you think only the 'Evil Sophist' knows how to use the 'Deceased Summoning Technique'?]

The Blood Demon looked at the approaching incarnations with bewildered eyes.

[Who do you think gave that skill to humans in the first place?]

"Even if you guys had that skill…!"

According to the Blood Demon's memory, Gong Pildu and Lee Hyunsung were not in a condition that could be revived even with [Deceased Summoning]. That's because they were literally torn to pieces and killed.

"You guys, what on earth did you do?"

Lee Hyunsung and Gong Pildu's bodies were briefly visible in the darkness. Countless incisions were sewn onto their skin from head to toe.

The Blood Demon's shoulders trembled.

Those crazy Constellations had collected the fragments of the torn incarnations for this moment. In order to bring them back to the hell of this scenario once again.

[Oh, actually, I worked hard to save your younger sibling too.]

"What?"

[The head just couldn't be restored.]

In Oedipus's grasp was the corpse of a child hanging without a head. Familiar arms and legs. The same ones he had seen in his dream just ten minutes ago.

A strange roar burst from the Blood Demon’s throat that was neither a scream nor a roar. How long did that roar last? At some point, the sound suddenly stopped, and a strange silence filled the underground.

"You guys."

The Blood Demon’s eyes, burning red, were gleaming at the Constellations.

"From now on, not a single one of you will return alive."

---

"So this is what you came here for."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had listened to my story to the end, looked at me with a dumbfounded expression.

"Of course. Why would I take such a risk?"

Since I invaded the Blood Demon's stronghold, I had been aiming for the Blood Demon and the Constellations' advance.

It was possible because I had already checked all the Blood Demon's skills, souls, and legends through [Character List].

"The Blood Demon must have activated 「Starlight-Eating Darkness」 by now."

A gigantic legend, 「Starlight-Eating Darkness」.

A terrifying gigantic legend that halved the power of the Constellations underground.

I wondered how a Blood Demon could have gotten such a legend, but when I searched my memory, it seemed to be a gigantic legend that the Blood Demon had obtained by interfering with something when the <Underworld> was destroyed due to Cheon Inho's sowing of discord.

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes lit up as he listened to the story.

"The Blood Demon might as well have a chance of winning."

"As long as the Myth-grade Constellations don't descend."

"Even if the Final Scenario had begun, there’s no way the cowardly Myth-grade would just leave the ark."

I think so too. The Constellations that attacked the Blood Demon’s stronghold were probably the remnants of Olympus's legends or great men.

"Still, it’s not a situation to be optimistic about. After all, they’re also Constellations that have reached the 'Final Scenario'. They’ve lived so long that their minds have hardened, but we should never overlook their power."

Then Ye Hyunwoo, who was listening to the conversation from the side, asked.

"Then which side do you think has the upper hand? The Blood Demon or the Constellations?"

"In my opinion…"

The moment I was about to answer, a bright light rose from Anna Croft's entire body. Kim Anna's soul had finally succeeded in settling down.

I called out to 'Anna Croft of the 41st Round' from the same world line as me.

I smiled at her as she slowly opened her eyes and opened my mouth. If [Deceased Summoning] had been successful, she would understand what I was saying.

"Kim Anna-ssi, welcome back to the 40th Round of this mess."

Anna Croft did not smile at my playful greeting. She slowly blinked her eyes as if she knew what she had to do, and stared at me. The 'Eyes of the Great Devil' were swirling in her eyes.

「Future Sight.」

She had already begun to read the future of this Round.

The Prophet left her first prophecy.

"Come."

At the same time, the iron door shook violently. The startled Ten Evils stood up from their seats, and Yoo Joonghyuk prepared for battle.

I asked Anna.

"Who is here?"

Anna didn't answer. Judging from the way she frowned, she seemed to be suffering from the aftereffects of possessing a body.

When I sent a signal to Yoo Joonghyuk with my eyes, he stood in front of the iron gate, raising his spirits.

Perhaps because of the reassurance that the tyrant was on the same side as them, the other Ten Evils' expressions seemed much more relaxed.

Kyung Sein muttered.

"Yeah. The tyrant is on our side, so what are we afraid of? What if Zeus comes—"

I watched the situation while holding onto Ye Hyunwoo's neck, who was already preparing to disappear.

Yoo Joonghyuk said.

"The Ki-moon formation is being dismantled."

It's not being broken, but dismantled? If that's the case, then the one opening the iron gate and coming in right now...

"As expected..."

With a squeak, the iron door opened. A single figure appeared in the flickering light.

"Blood Demon."

He was covered in blood, and with his right arm missing, he was glaring at me with a menacing gaze.

I asked with a grin.

"Did you enjoy the dumplings?"

The fact that the Blood Demon had appeared here meant that he had killed the Constellations and had his subordinates surround this place.

I had to buy some time until Anna could find the answer through [Future Sight].

"Cheon Inho."

A voice as if blood was boiling flowed from the Blood Demon's throat.

I took a step back and said.

"No, would you like to talk for a moment? Come on, calm down…"

However, the Blood Demon staggered toward me, then knelt down in front of me. Then he looked up at me.

He had an expression on his face that I had never seen before.

It seemed like he was grateful, it seemed like he was laughing at me, it seemed like he was angry at me… and it seemed like he was sympathizing with me.

The Blood Demon spoke as if he was calming down all those emotions.

"You are now the last of humanity."

With a slap, the Blood Demon's head fell to the ground. Something had cut off the Blood Demon's neck.

In that unrealistic scenery, I slowly raised my head. A shiver ran down my spine.

A skill that could kill a Blood Demon-level master with a single swing.

I knew what this skill was. A wounded swordsman who trained and trained again with the sword, and eventually reached the pinnacle of swordsmanship, created a finishing move.

"Instant Kill."

The moment I raised my head, a flash of light flashed before my eyes.

I felt time slowing down. It was too late to use [Incite]. The moment the distant feeling came over me, a man in a pitch-black coat was standing before my eyes.

"Step back."

A loud explosion and a bouncing, straight shot.

Tsk tsk tsk.

A spark bursting out fiercely.

Yoo Joonghyuk's penalty, 「Curse of the Stars」, had been activated.

「When Yoo Joonghyuk fights against an incarnation, his level is reduced to one-tenth.」

A group of Constellations could be seen walking from afar. Athena, Apollo, Artemis, Dionysus. Four out of the Twelve Gods of <Olympus> were there.

The Constellations approached, killing the corpses that had gone mad after the Blood Demon died one by one.

And the incarnations that stood guard over them.

Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at the incarnations with eyes that could not read his expression.

From Lee Jihye, who had just used Instant Kill on me, to Lee Hyunsung, Gong Pildu, and even Kim Namwoon.

Looking at their appearances, which were all piled up like old dolls, it was clear what had happened.

The damn Constellations had revived them with [Deceased Summoning].

[What a strange thing, Supreme King, how did you come back to life? Your soul must have already left this world line?]

A subtle strangeness flashed through Apollo's eyes.

[Take him to Hermes. It might be worth studying.]

At the same time, the four incarnations surrounded Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You idiots. Come to your senses."

The four incarnations did not respond to Yoo Joonghyuk's threats.

Judging from their appearances, it seemed that they had not been revived with a simple [Deceased Summoning]. Perhaps they had used a high-level brainwashing skill, or they had already summoned and transplanted a destroyed soul.

In either case, it was the worst possible situation.

[Supreme King, these are your comrades. You know very well that no matter what you do, you cannot win.]

"…"

[If you surrender now, I will give you a chance to board the ark with us.]

A chance to board the ark.

Apollo was making a proposal to Yoo Joonghyuk right now. To him, a mere incarnation, they will give him the same 'qualification' as the Constellations in the Last Scenario.

Of course, the answer was set.

"I refuse."

The power of a Transcendent bloomed from his entire body.

Yoo Joonghyuk jumped forward in an instant and swung his Hwangcheon-wolguk toward the front.

"No matter how many times I regress, I will never ride the same ship as you guys."

The formation guarded by the four incarnations collapsed after only drawing a single trajectory. It was an unbelievable power to have displayed only one-tenth of his power.

After all, that Yoo Joonghyuk was a madman who broke through the encirclement of the great Constellations and killed Ares even without Hwangcheon-wolguk.

"Lee Hyunsung. If you block, you'll die."

Lee Hyunsung's front was cut wide by the Hwangcheon-wolguk's blade that shot out like a flash. I felt strange at his movements, completely unaware that he had once been his comrade.

I know. That's Yoo Joonghyuk. This situation wasn't the first time. Even so, I felt strange seeing that guy.

"Evil sophist. There's no time. The tyrant is overdoing it. He can't last long against the incarnations."

My mind was complicated as I listened to Ye Hyunwoo's advice. What can I do now? What can I do to 'properly' save that Yoo Joonghyuk?

That's when Anna Croft muttered from behind.

"Staging."

Staging?

"Get out!"

Along with Yoo Joonghyuk's shout, a hail of bullets swept across the front. A few bullets grazed my side, causing a dizzying pain.

These were Gong Pildu's bullets that had reached the Final Scenario.

Yoo Joonghyuk swung his spear and protected his party while taking the bullets head-on.

Suga-gak!

Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon's sharp blades cut Yoo Joonghyuk's arms and legs.

Boom! Lee Hyunsung’s heavy fist struck Yoo Joonghyuk’s stomach.

Even as he let out a gasp, Yoo Joonghyuk didn’t take a single step back.

Not a single step.

"Cheon Inho."

That single step was so heavy that I realized a little late that he had called me.

The moment our eyes met, I realized what Yoo Joonghyuk was thinking. The terrible thoughts I was having right now were also Yoo Joonghyuk's thoughts.

"Use 「Staging」."

Actually, I knew. Even before I heard Anna Croft’s words, I knew what I had to do now.

That’s because the memories of death that came to my mind clearly the moment I saw Lee Hyunsung, Gong Pildu, Lee Jihye, and Kim Namwoon again.

That’s right.

Right now, those people in front of me—

"They’re all people you’ve killed."

They all died 'once' at the hands of Cheon Inho.

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[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 849 Episode 45 Ten Evils (7)

"Cheon Inho! That's it! Use 「Staging」!"

It seemed that Ten Evils had belatedly come to the same realization as Yoo Joonghyuk.

"There must be a story that you got from defeating those guys!"

There is.

There must have been stories inside me that I was afraid to even recall.

[Story, 'Destroyer of the Underworld', is wriggling inside you.]

[Story, 'Jester of Hell', awaits your choice.]

[Story, 'Star Mocking Feast', awaits your mockery.]

Stories, all of which were created by piling up terrible evil deeds.

Stories are memories. The incarnations that died during their creation.

[Stories await your reenactment.]

I hesitated. Was it really okay to reenact these stories here?

While I hesitated, Oedipus's order was given.

[The rest, except for the Supreme King, die.]

The incarnations that had taken over Yoo Joonghyuk's defense began to launch a full-scale offensive.

Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body was stricken by Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon's consecutive attacks, and Yoo Joonghyuk's face turned pale every time Lee Hyunsung's [Mt. Taesang Smash], which took advantage of the gap, struck.

On top of that, Gong Pildu's [Magic Turret] poured out without a hitch.

[Indeed.]

Oedipus was watching us from behind the armed fortress, with the four Constellations.

To be honest, it was a bit disappointing. Apollo and Artemis are one thing, but Athena is the goddess of justice... Damn, she came to judge the Ten Evils, so it isn't strange?

But isn't it a bit strange that Dionysus is involved? I didn't think the Constellation would be in this situation.

Upon closer inspection, Dionysus's eyes were dull as if he had lost interest. He continued to sip the wine in his left hand with empty eyes. If you think about it, not all Dionysus are the same as the 1,864th Round. He must have gone through a lot on his way to the Final Scenario.

Apollo added in a nonchalant voice.

[Those who seem useful, leave their heads.]

It seems that there was quite a bit of trouble in the fight against the Blood Demon, and the Constellations including Apollo looked a little tired.

In that case, we still have a chance.

I looked back at the Ten Evils and said.

"I won't use the staging."

"What?"

I looked at the Ten Evils' frightened faces one by one and continued.

"We have to show that we can win without relying on the power of staging."

In the first place, if the Ten Evils don't surpass <Kim Dokja's Company>, they won't be able to see the end of the 40th Round.

In short, if they can defeat them without using 'staging', they will be eligible to see the final chapter of the scenario.

[The master of the 'Time Fault' is very interested in your judgment.]

[The 'King of Fear' agrees with your decision.]

The Ten Evils gaped at my decision as if it was ridiculous.

Yoo Joonghyuk also glanced back in the middle of the fight, and Anna Croft, who had been continuing her prophecies one by one, stared at me with strange eyes.

The two seemed to be surprised by my decision in a slightly different sense.

Kyung Sein shouted as if she was frustrated.

"Why are you going back when there is an easy way?"

Her question was valid.

But.

"The easy way is not always the right way."

You shouldn't use staged scenes. What should I say? For a fundamental reason, I didn't want to recreate the stage of those stories.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was pushed to the back with a thud, stood next to me.

"What are you planning?"

The guy's eyes were burning brightly as if he had read my mind.

"If you care about me, then just leave it at that. I've already experienced the deaths of my comrades dozens of times."

"Of course."

This kind of pain must certainly be familiar to Yoo Joonghyuk.

But does that mean it’s okay to say that it’s not pain?

"It’s just that I don’t want to use it. It’s no fun if I win easily."

I smiled brightly as I dodged the flying sword.

Maybe Cheon Inho used 'Staging' in the 40th Round. And that’s what the 'Evil Sophist' wanted.

But I had no intention of unconditionally following the rules of the 40th Round.

I’ll do it my way.

Even if I lose here, I won’t use the method of digging up Yoo Joonghyuk’s scars.

Ye Hyunwoo nodded as if he understood the situation and opened his mouth.

"I see. I’ll disappear now."

"Ye Hyunwoo."

I asked while holding onto Ye Hyunwoo’s arm.

"Don’t you want to see the end of the scenarios?"

"That kind of thing—"

"How long are you going to 'disappear'? If I die here, do you think you'll be okay after returning with [Deceased Summoning]?"

"But you can't win against those guys. We're not on the same level."

"On the same level? Are you really running away because of that?"

I looked back at the four incarnations engaged in a fierce battle with Yoo Joonghyuk and said.

"You can run away if you want. But you've run away many times so far."

I continued speaking to Kang Ilhun, Lee Dansu, and Kyung Sein who were watching us.

"Will you be like that even in the Last Scenario?"

Some characters are born as villains and die as villains. That's because there was no room for them to change. The writer didn't leave any sentences for them. It had to be that way in the main story.

But what about this world line?

The three of them looked at each other to see what they were thinking. Their wavering eyes crossed.

Lee Dansu was the first to speak.

"What do you want from us?"

"Even if you die again, I will revive you as much as I want. So please save me this time."

I explained the plan through [group chat]. As expected of the Ten Evils, they quickly understood my plan.

—As expected, it was a plan created by the 'Evil Sophist'.

Once again, [Mt. Taesun Smash] exploded. Now, Yoo Joonghyuk, who had reached his limit, was being pushed back.

The moment Lee Hyunsung, who did not miss the opportunity, was about to activate [Mt. Taesun Smash] again.

"Kang Ilhun"

Kang Ilhun ran towards Lee Hyunsung at the same time as my signal.

"Wow! Why is Zeus in a place like that!"

[Character, 'Kang Ilhun', activates his exclusive skill 'Rumor Lv.???'!]

The startled incarnations looked back for a moment. Of course, there was nothing there.

Lee Hyunsung, enraged, turned around and ripped Kang Ilhun's neck off.

Kang Ilhun's neck, flying through the air, shouted.

"Now!"

The moment Lee Hyunsung belatedly noticed something was wrong and looked around, a voice was heard from below.

"You're late, Steel Sword Emperor."

Dozens of 'traps' were set up in a split second.

Traps are not very effective against the deceased. However, if there are dozens of traps instead of just one, it's a different story.

A suffocating gas trap burst out around Lee Hyunsung. Lee Hyunsung's body, which had stepped on more than ten traps in an instant, began to petrify rapidly.

"Hahaha! This is a trap made from the legend of Medusa! Even if you are the Steel Sword Emperor, you won't be able to move for five minutes with this..."

Lee Hyunsung, who had been frozen with a thud, stretched out his right arm with all his might. Lee Dansu, who had been letting his guard down, was pierced in the chest in vain.

"Bam..."

Two of the Ten Evils died in order to subdue Lee Hyunsung alone. However, there was no time to hesitate. There were still three enemies left.

"Ah, no. I'm different from other guys. I can never fight them!"

Kyung Sein instinctively recognized the 'strong' and stepped back, her legs shaking. Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon were approaching her, emitting wild fighting spirit.

Kyung Sein's judgment was right. If we confronted them now, Lee Jihye's [Instant Kill] would immediately cut off her head.

But what if we did this?

"Kyung Sein."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

"From now on, 'Lee Jihye' and 'Kim Namwoon' are weaker than you."

A fierce spark flew before her eyes. [Incite], whose power was further strengthened by [Strengthening Sentences].

Kyung Sein groaned as if in pain.

Changing the target of [Insect Massacre] through [Incite].

If I did this to a story, which wasn't even a skill, the story could easily get twisted and her body could explode. Nevertheless, Kyung Sein accepted my [incite].

[The story of the 'Insect Massacre' is distorted!]

[An abnormal discrepancy occurs in the story!]

Kyung Sein laughed amidst the bright sparks of probability.

"I feel like I'm the main character."

Kyung Sein ran out at a fast pace and engaged in a close fight with Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon.

Kyung Sein's bare fist landed on Lee Jihye's side, and her sweeping kick struck the Delusion Demon's stomach.

A mere Ten Evils were engaged in a duel with the 'Maritime Admiral' and the 'Delusion Demon'.

Of course, it was only a short-term trick to gain some time, but that was exactly what we needed.

[Supreme King! Where did the Supreme King go?]

The quick-witted Oedipus shouted. A shadow of anxiety flashed across his eyes. Soon, the bastard pointed at me with his finger and screamed.

[Kill him! Kill the Evil Sophist! It's over if we just kill him!]

Gong Pildu's [Magic Turret] was aimed at me. Oedipus' judgment was indeed accurate.

In the end, everyone here was the ones I revived with [Deceased Summoning].

The moment I die, they will also rapidly lose their vitality.

But.

"That's the same for you too."

The moment Oedipus, with his eyes wide open, turned around, there was 'The Disappearing One' Ye Hyunwoo and Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk's Hwangcheon-wolguk, imbued with terrifying transcendence, emitted light.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.

Deadly Swordsmanship.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship's secret technique arranged with spear technique.

Iljeom Breaking the Sky.

A storm of strong energy swept through the entire platform along with Oedipus' scream.

I lay face down on the floor and waited for the aftershock to pass. Not long after, a message came to my ear.

[The Constellation, 'One Who Stabbed His Own Eye', has left the scenario.]

Oedipus, who had suffered a terrible blow, finally left the scenario.

Following this, with a creaking sound, Yoo Joonghyuk's colleagues who had been summoned with [Deceased Summoning] knelt down one by one and collapsed. The souls that had been forcibly injected were leaving their bodies.

Gong Pildu's Armed Fortress collapsed, and then the Delusion Demon Kim Namwoon fell.

Lee Jihye and Lee Hyunsung were looking somewhere without falling until the very end.

At the end of their gaze, a man was standing.

"Rest. I will confirm the end of this world."

Only after hearing Yoo Joonghyuk's words did the two close their eyes as if they were relieved.

"We... won?"

In the meantime, Ye Hyunwoo muttered by my side, and Kyung Sein, who was sitting on the dusty ground nearby, shouted.

"Euhahahahaha! Euhahahahaha! How is it? this is the Ten Evils! You sons of bitches!"

And then applause was heard from somewhere. Beyond the collapsed Armed Fortress, four Constellations were walking.

[It was a story enough to be included as a 'tale' in the ark.]

They were the four Constellations, including Apollo.

At the same time, a bright light flashed, and Yoo Joonghyuk shouted.

"Be careful!"

Yoo Joonghyuk ran forward and swung his spear at the flying beam of light, but the beam missed Yoo Joonghyuk's spear at a strange angle.

I looked into whose skill it was.

「Mysterious Tracking Arrow.」

It was the specialty of Artemis, one of the Twelve Gods of <Olympus>. The three arrows that flew in hit Kyung Sein, who was catching her breath, and Ye Hyunwoo, who was standing next to me.

And the last one.

Psshh.

I held back a scream and sat down on the floor. Bloody stories flowed out from my pierced thigh.

Apollo said that he liked the sight of us.

[But every story has an end.]

They didn't seem intimidated at all even after seeing Yoo Joonghyuk's divine power that killed Oedipus with one blow.

No matter how strong Yoo Joonghyuk was, there were four of the Twelve Gods on the other side. And unlike before, there was no 「Darkness That Eats Starlight」 that suppressed the Constellations.

[Kill the tyrant.]

With the signal, the four Constellations disappeared from sight. Almost at the same time, Yoo Joonghyuk's divine form also disappeared. A rough cracking sound rang out in the air, and a wave of magical power that seemed to rip through the eardrums burst out. Occasionally, fragments of stories fell to the ground. It was evidence that a fierce battle was taking place somewhere unseen.

[Supreme King! Is this all you can do? Hahaha! Try to entertain us a little more!]

Yoo Joonghyuk was under the 「Curse of the Stars」. However, even if his level increased against the Constellations, his opponents were four Narrative-grade Constellations.

I recalled the way Cheon Inho had fought in my head.

Could I do the same? If I moved now, could I subdue those Constellations together with Yoo Joonghyuk?

"Cheon Inho, you can run away now."

Ye Hyunwoo, who was holding the holed ship, touched my shoulder.

"Give up the Supreme King. If even the Evil Sophist dies, humanity is finished."

[You can't win.]

As if he had eavesdropped on our conversation, Apollo's message came through the light that was aiming at us.

[Here, there are Myth-grade Constellations in the ark! Now, neither 'Final Tong' nor 'Divine Spirit of the Other World' can help you! No matter what you do, there is no way to deal with them!]

Myth-grade Constellations. The moment I heard that name, my heart sank like lead. The only ones blocking us now were Narrative-grade Constellations.

If the Narrative-grade is like this, how can we deal with the Myth-grade?

[With the stories you have accumulated, you will never reach the 'End of the Scenarios'. Did you think you were gods just because you were lucky enough to drop a few Constellations?]

I saw Yoo Joonghyuk's body falling from the sky.

The white-hot Apollo was looking at me.

[The last human on the small planet. You fought well enough.]

Maybe the 40th Round's Cheon Inho's battle wasn't over until here.

「But.」

Maybe he died in front of the ark without seeing the end.

「Then what is the meaning of 'rewriting' this story?」

That's when Anna Croft's voice came from behind me.

"Head."

When I turned my head absentmindedly, Anna Croft's gaze was directed somewhere.

There lay the dead head of the Blood Demon.

A strange thought suddenly occurred to me. Why on earth did the Blood Demon come all the way here?

If he had been betrayed by the Constellations anyway, if he had known that he was destined to die—

「Why did he come all the way here to die in front of me?」

I suddenly raised my head and looked at the warehouse. According to my memory, the Blood Demon had spent his entire life collecting treasures from this warehouse.

But.

「This warehouse, isn't it a little small?」

I picked up the Blood Demon's head that had fallen to the ground. Then, the Blood Demon's head seemed to be speaking to me.

Think about it, there's a reason he came here to find me and died.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had landed on the ground, jumped up while howling like a wild beast. Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes, glancing at me, were telling me something. Now he could barely hold on.

[You who live for a mere hundred years, how dare you look down upon the sky of Constellations!]

A being who lives for a mere hundred years.

At that moment, a voice came to mind. It was the voice of the Blood Demon.

「"What do you think a being who lives for a mere hundred years would have to do to break a Constellation?"」

My head was throbbing and hurting.

「"It would take a many great people to join forces."」

「"That's impossible, you Evil Sophist."」

「"Can't you do it?"」

I thought as I recalled the conversation flowing in my head.

「"There's no need for only living people to join forces, right?"」

If my hypothesis was correct,

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Just hold on a little longer."

As if it heard me, a loud noise rose from the distant sky.

I dragged my injured leg and walked somewhere while holding the Blood Demon's head.

Artemis sensed something strange and shot an arrow at me. I heard someone behind me taking the arrow instead of me.

Without looking back, I continued walking toward the end of the warehouse.

There was a small safe there. A dark-colored safe, a safe that had been bothering me since a while ago but I had not found a way to open it.

I sat down in front of the safe, and a faint light flowed out from it.

[Confirming the legend embedded in the retina.]

I brought the Blood Demon's head to it. Then, the dead Blood Demon's head opened its eyes as if it had come back to life.

[Confirming the owner's legend.]

A subspace portal opened before my eyes.

I realized it instinctively.

I see, this portal is—

"Cheon Inho, take the Prophet."

Ye Hyunwoo, who had two holes in his upper body from Artemis' arrows, pushed Anna, who still had difficulty moving, to me.

My body began to be sucked into the portal along with Anna, who collapsed.

Maybe he thought this was the end, Ye Hyunwoo looked at me for a moment. Then he smiled at me for the first time.

"Thank you for bringing us here."

The moment I was about to call his name, Apollo's flash of light exploded.

The sound of something burning. A cruel scream echoed.

The other space swallowed all that tragedy and closed the portal.

As I gasped for breath and got up, I felt the cold floor.

"Anna Croft, are you here?"

Anna Croft groaned and nodded at my voice.

"The hidden warehouse of the Blood Demon."

The moment I reached out to the empty space, a light came on in the ceiling. Almost at the same time, lightning flashed in my head.

「"Cheon Inho."」

That was the last day of the <Underworld>.

It was a conversation between Cheon Inho and the Blood Demon.

「"Even if I use my 'story', it won't be able to turn all humans into undead."」

「"Hmm? Is that so?"」

Listening to the conversation flowing in my head, I slowly looked around the warehouse. It was a space that was almost the size of a stadium.

「"Some bodies have such strong thoughts that my 'King of the Dead' can't resurrect them. Especially the ones you mentioned—"」

Thousands of heads and torsos that had been 'preserved' were hanging all over the warehouse.

「"Hmm. That doesn't matter. Collect them for the future."」

A trembling slowly rose from the tips of my feet. I gradually quickened my pace and examined the heads. Soon enough, familiar faces appeared one by one.

「"There may come a day when they change their minds and revive to save the world."」

I stopped in front of the heads that were all too familiar. The heads of the Transcendents that the Blood Demon had failed to turn into corpses were on display there.

Some heads were too small, and some too large. There were also heads that still had the same ferocious expressions from their lives.

Some made me feel like crying, but I held it in. This was because I thought of the people who were watching me like this somewhere.

"Are you watching?"

I reached out my trembling hands toward the heads hanging on the wall.

"If you are watching."

I don't know if this is the right way to resolve this Fear or not. However, this was the way I chose.

A way to 'properly' save Yoo Joonghyuk.

I will safely finish the 40th Round and protect the Fear Realm.

I muttered while holding the heads of Cheok Jungyeong and Kyrgios.

And at that moment.

"Masters. Please help me."

The last sentence of this world began to be written in my head.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 850 Episode 46 Big Joke (1)

Yoo Joonghyuk opened his eyes in the darkness. No, strictly speaking, it wasn't darkness. It was just that his eyes were covered with a blindfold, so he couldn't see ahead.

He felt firm restraints on his limbs, and no matter how much he tried, they wouldn't come off, so it was at least a restraint device made of a metal called stories.

'Is this how it ended up?'

Yoo Joonghyuk bit his lips tightly and checked his physical fatigue. Judging from his condition, it seemed like at least a week had passed since he passed out.

After catching his breath, he tried to recall the memories that were coming to him here and there. Fortunately, the memories of the last moment when he lost consciousness were clear.

「[Hahahaha! In the end, you were abandoned by your colleagues, Supreme King!]」

Apollo's despicable laughter.

The moment when he was directly hit by the attacks of the four Narrative-grade Constellations, the memory of his defense breaking and missing the Hwangcheon-moongeuk. The dazzling portal that opened in the warehouse and the image of Cheon Inho disappearing into it. He didn’t know where Cheon Inho went. He might have gone to

another dimension, or he might have gone to the secret place hidden by the Blood Demon. He just hoped that he survived safely, no matter where he went.

However, he also had a feeling that even if he survived safely, he wouldn’t be able to save him. Because,

'We’ve finally come to the ark.'

This was the residence of the Myth-grade Constellations of the 'Final Scenario'. It was the 'Final Ark'.

Just by breathing quietly, he could feel the immense power of the Myth-grade Constellations located somewhere beyond this room.

"Is this it?"

What would happen if he failed a task in the Fear Realm? Even though he had already experienced over forty regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk didn’t know much about the Fear Realm. Sometimes they just disappear, and sometimes they become a 'Fear' that resides in the Fear Realm. In particular, the more powerful the incarnation, the more likely they are to turn into a powerful 'Fear' if they fail.

If that's the case now, he would be at least a 'Disaster-level Fear'; or a monster greater than a 'Natural Disaster-level Fear'.

Then, Cheon Inho would tease him, saying, "Oh my. You've truly become a 'Natural Disaster-level Fear King'."

If he's not lucky enough, he'll end up being killed by the master who came to defeat him.

Then this round will be over.

'Still, there were a lot of things that happened.'

He felt regretful when he thought it was the end. He thought that he would finally be able to see the end of the scenarios this time.

More than anything, it seemed possible if that guy who possessed Cheon Inho was there.

'That guy.'

The guy who suddenly appeared in the 41st Round. The guy who fed him dirt, dumplings, and kept saying strange things. The guy who didn't reveal his name.

He had questions he wanted to ask that guy.

Why on earth did you, who are not even Cheon Inho, come to this world line?

Who on earth are you?

Why did you become my colleague?

Why on earth do you always have that expression on your face as if you are atoning for something?

That was when he felt someone's presence.

Yoo Joonghyuk calmly gathered his thoughts and opened his mouth.

"Who are you?"

There was no answer. All he could feel was a terrible alcohol smell.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been silent for a moment, asked again.

"Are you the God of Wine and Ecstasy?"

Someone took off his blindfold along with the pungent smell of alcohol.

[Yes, it's me.]

Dionysus, holding a bottle of wine in one hand, was grinning before his eyes.

[Unfortunately, you survived, Supreme King. It would have been better for you if you had just died.]

"What are you here for?"

[Well, do I need a reason to visit a friend?]

Friend?

Yoo Joonghyuk's indifferent eyebrows twitched. "I've never been friends with you."

At that, Dionysus snickered. Dionysus, who had been blowing his whistle briefly, burped softly and answered.

[I had a few friends who liked you. They're all dead now. Friends of friends are my friends.]

Yoo Joonghyuk thought of the dead Constellations belonging to <Eden> and <Emperor>. Maybe some of them were friends with Dionysus.

[The Constellations will come to dissect you soon.]

"Why are you telling me that?"

[Because we're friends.]

"<Olympus> seems to treat friends like this."

[When Hermes comes, you'll definitely die and be torn to pieces. Your soul and every piece of your stories will be completely disintegrated. So—]

After saying that, Dionysus took another sip of his drink and walked around the room for a while, carrying his luggage like a scholar.

[Explain why I should save you.]

"What?"

[I'm giving you one last chance. One last chance to survive.]

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't understand.

He originally knew that the 'God of Wine and Ecstasy' was an oddball even within <Olympus>.

But why is he suddenly bringing up this topic? Is it a trap?

But is there a reason to set up such a trap?

"Why would you do something like that? Are you thinking of betraying <Olympus>?"

[I'm getting a little bored.]

Dionysus shrugged his shoulders with his characteristically bored expression and leaned against the wall where Yoo Joonghyuk was restrained.

[Honestly, don't you think it's pathetic?]

"..."

[The Constellations have no intention of clearing the scenario. They have no intention of checking the Final Wall, and they've long since forgotten their curiosity about this world. They're just thinking about boarding the ark and escaping to another world line. Because I'm so scared of destruction coming.]

Dionysus muttered as he looked into the distant sky.

The sky of the <Star Stream> was not visible in this room. Maybe that's why he could keep saying these things.

[Everyone is scared. They're afraid that this 'stage' we enjoy will really end. They're afraid that all the history we've enjoyed, all the status we've had, will disappear in vain with just one wall being torn down.]

Maybe it was because he had never seen Dionysus this honest before. Yoo Joonghyuk listened to him in silence.

[But you guys were different. Honestly, I was impressed by you a week ago.]

The moment he heard that story, Yoo Joonghyuk thought of Cheon Inho's words.

「"Even if nothing changes in the story, it means that the person reading the story can change."」

Maybe the Dionysus in front of him was like that too.

A strange heat was rippling in Dionysus's eyes.

[No matter how I looked at it, it was a fight that you couldn't possibly win. There was no chance of winning.]

"..."

[Tell me, why are you guys fighting so hard?]

Yoo Joonghyuk thought as he looked at Dionysus.

「How would that guy answer?」

Yoo Joonghyuk thought for a moment and then spoke as if he were that guy.

"To save the world."

[World? What is a world? All of humanity is dead, right? Your comrades, and the people you cared about are all dead. Regressor Yoo Joonghyuk. Why haven't you left this world line yet?]

"Dionysus. If you're curious about the 'end of everything,' release me right now."

[Huh?]

"The end of this world line has already been decided. You guys are going to lose anyway. And the last one to survive is that damn 'Star-Deceiver' Cheon Inho."

In fact, even Yoo Joonghyuk doesn't really know what the end of this world line is. Still, he talked nonsense like that.

Because that's what he would have said.

[What does that mean?]

And his strategy was very effective.

[Hermes said something similar. The end of this world line is already decided. Tell me straight. What on earth does that mean?]

"If you want to hear more—"

The moment he said that, a commotion was heard from outside the door.

[Damn. I have to hide for a moment.]

Dionysus's body transformed into a crude wine bottle and was placed on a nearby table. It was a perfect hiding that even hid the Constellation's status.

Then a group of Constellations appeared. They were the Historical-grade Constellations under Hermes.

The Constellations were sharing a square table, and in the center of the table was Hermes's head wearing a black blindfold.

How much time had passed like that? Hermes opened his mouth.

[This is strange. Are you really the 'Supreme King'?]

Hermes continued to ask after a pause.

[According to the 'regression' mechanism that I know, you cannot return here with 'Deceased Summoning'. We have tried several times but failed. Who are you? Where did you come from?]

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."

At that moment, a faint mechanical sound and sparks flowed over Hermes's head. Then Hermes' expression changed subtly.

[Amazing. You are really Yoo Joonghyuk.]

It seemed that he had activated some kind of skill to verify that Yoo Joonghyuk's words were true.

[So, can we finally learn about the 'End of Everything'?]

"The End of Everything? What does that mean?"

[The prophecy of the three Moirai Sisters. Have you already forgotten?]

The moment he heard those words, fragments of memories flashed through his head.

The words of prophecy vaguely rose above the traces of memory erased by the 'Story Imprint'.

「Incarnation Yoo Joonghyuk. Everything in this universe will end forever in your 'next regression'.」

He had definitely heard that prophecy before.

However, he couldn't quite recall why he had heard that prophecy and what exactly it meant.

Hermes continued to speak.

[Cooperate with us, Yoo Joonghyuk. Every Constellation in this sky has a duty to stop the desires of all things. We must know why that prophecy came down and what it means.]

"Unfortunately, I also don't know what that prophecy means."

[Don't lie. You knew back then. You definitely—]

"I've lost my memory."

A faint mechanical sound was heard once again, and Hermes, who confirmed the fact, was shocked and blurted out,

[What the heck...]

"I told you. I don't know anything."

[There's nothing I can do. I'll open your head. We'll search for your memories in your subconscious.]

"Wasn't that your intention from the beginning?"

Yoo Joonghyuk added with a sneer.

"Even if you open my head, you won't find the answer you want. My memories are not passed down through my head, but through my soul."

Then Hermes smiled brightly.

[I already know that much. Don't worry. This time, I plan to borrow the power of the Nebulae and extract your soul.]

"What?"

He had never had his soul captured by anyone before. The Giant Nebulae had never tried to capture him so deliberately.

Extracting his soul.

Is that possible?

If it were really possible, then maybe it would be possible here.

Wouldn't it be possible to find a way to stop his regression?

But if that really happens, what will happen to his 41st Round?

"Wait."

Before Yoo Joonghyuk could stop him, Hermes's subordinates moved.

[Open the head and extract the soul.]

The scalpel made of story metal drew a clean trajectory, aiming for his head.

And the next moment.

Bang!

With a pleasant metallic cracking sound, the scalpel made of story metal broke in half.

[Exclusive trait, 'Stone Head', is activated.]

[Your head cannot be destroyed by physical force.]

Hermes opened his mouth in surprise.

[Supreme King, what on earth did you do?]

"I didn't do it."

Yoo Joonghyuk muttered, not even realizing that he was snickering.

"It was done by a guy who is good at making dumplings."

[I don't know what you're talking about.]

The view in the room slowly darkened. He felt the vast amount of stories that had been stored inside the ark gather around Hermes.

[The joke ends here. The Myth-grade Constellations are watching.]

Yoo Joonghyuk sank to his core.

No matter how strong his mind was, if the Myth-grade Constellations were to carry the probability of a giant nebula, there was no way it wouldn’t split.

But then.

—Hey.

Dionysus, who had turned into a wine bottle, spoke.

—Something quite interesting happened outside just now.

Then, with a thud, the ark shook violently. Hermes groaned in confusion, and emergency lights flashed all over the ark.

[Anyone! Who on earth would dare—]

It was obvious who had done it.

Yoo Joonghyuk became anxious because he knew who would do it.

'That guy can’t do it alone.'

No matter how great he was, even if the Ten Evils were with him, attacking the ark with just those members was no different from committing suicide.

—I don't know where they got those things from. This is why the <Star Stream> is fun.

The next moment, a screen that the Constellations were watching appeared in front of Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Is that the 'world' you were trying to protect?

What happened?

There were beings that could never exist in this 'Time Fault'.

Famous voices could be faintly heard.

"Isn't this the first time that all the generals have been possessed at once?"

"Surprisingly, such healthy incarnations remained?"

There were also transcendental beings whose faces he only knew.

"This is really, I don't know what kind of trouble I'm having because I've got the wrong disciple."

There was also a man with a ferocious face that he had once aimed for.

"If you have a bad disciple, the master will suffer."

There was also a small man with a strength that he could not help but acknowledge.

And there was a giant being standing at the center of them.

The moment he saw that face, Yoo Joonghyuk's heart swelled without him knowing it. Her brightly shining eyes stared at him beyond the screen.

"But even if he is a worthless disciple."

Captain of the Second Division of the Transcendent Alliance, Sky Breaking Namgung Minyoung.

"Once a disciple, always a disciple."

His master came to save him.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 851 Episode 46 Big Joke (2)

The Constellations of the ark, who had received the emergency alarm, began to descend to the ground all at once.

[Foolish guys.]

The first thing that caught my eye was the Historical-grade Constellation at the forefront, shouting and swinging their greatsword.

It was a Constellation belonging to the Argo Expeditionary Force, the giant gate <Olympus>.

[How dare you know where this is—]

That was the extent of the advice he was allowed to give. The Constellation's incarnation was split in two by the sword of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

The indignant Historical-grade Constellations each radiated anger and fell to the ground like shooting stars.

"Shoot."

At the signal of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, the Transcendent Constellations lined up at the rear all aimed their bows at the sky.

[Mortals!]

The Constellations that had been emitting their fierceness in the air along with the tiresome mortal rhetoric exploded in the sky.

Super strong mana.

A bundle of arrows with the stories of the Transcendents added, far superior to [Strong Mana]. The arrows of the Transcendents, who had already experienced countless wars like this, were accurate and sharp.

[What the—]

The Constellations that descended confidently were hit by arrows before they could even set foot on the ground, and their fates were sealed.

The Constellations that were lucky enough to land were also unable to block the single sword of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

[Kwaaaaah!]

Although they were Historical-grade Constellations, they were Constellations that were considered great wherever they went. Those Constellations were being cut off by a single sword.

A few of the quick-witted Historical-grade sensed something was wrong and lifted their bodies.

[Where are you going?]

But the Twelve Gods, including Apollo, had already arrived there.

As Apollo lightly blew off the heads of the Historical-grade Constellations that were running away, the Historical-grade Constellations who changed their positions again shouted loudly.

[The Twelve Gods have arrived!]

[Everyone, wake up! The enemy is just an incarnation!]

But before their battle line could be fully formed, the order of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was given once again.

"Cut it."

"It's going to happen anyway."

Cheok Jungyeong stepped forward, grumbling. His entire body, which had taken a stance with his sword, began to condense a huge amount of fighting spirit.

The moment the Constellations, feeling a sense of crisis, were about to utter a warning.

One Sword Cuts Thousands.

The Constellations in the battle line were split in half. Literally cutting a thousand with one stroke, a flawless and perfect swordsmanship.

Although the opponents were Constellations, so he couldn't really cut a thousand, dozens of Constellations died with that one cut.

Some Constellations muttered in amazement at Cheok Jungyeong's incredible power.

[I know, this is ridiculous...]

[Get out of the way.]

In the end, the Twelve Gods who couldn't stand it anymore stepped forward. They also had an intuition. The humans in front of them had power that even the Narrative-grade Constellations couldn't look down on.

Apollo glared at Cheok Jungyeong and asked.

[You must have been destroyed during 'The Last Dragon', so how did you come back?]

Cheok Jungyeong smirked and then showed off his hidden status without holding back.

[The Constellation 'Goryeo's First Sword' reveals his status.]

Even the Narrative-grade Constellations' expressions hardened at the general-level aggression that was encroaching on the area. Cheok Jungyeong said.

[I always wanted to test it. How strong is that great 'Olympus Twelve Gods' level?]

Cheok Jungyeong's whole body simultaneously swelled with the power of a Constellation and transcendence.

Third Captain of the Transcendent Alliance, Goryeo's best swordsman Cheok Jungyeong. With the strongest incarnation body in history, he was one of the few beings in this world who possessed the power of both a Constellation and transcendence.

Apollo said with a sullen voice.

[Do you really have to fight with us? Aren't you a Constellation after all?]

[You have to pay the price for making my only disciple suffer by using that Constellation's modifier.]

[Disciple? Who are you talking about?]

[A guy who makes dumplings well.]

Cheok Jungyeong jumped at that signal. Almost at the same time, a bright artificial sun rose behind Apollo's back. A blazing heat that would burn the earth swept over, but Cheok Jungyeong merely laughed as if it was ridiculous.

[As rumored, you hang a toy on your head.]

[What?]

[It seems that you haven’t inherited the position of Sun God from Helios yet?]

Was that a reversal? The enraged Apollo let out a rippling corona. The flame of the corona was carried directly onto Apollo’s bow.

[You arrogant bastard. I’ll burn you so you never come back to life.]

Apollo, aiming at the ground, released the bowstring. The arrows shot out with swirling flames soon scattered into hundreds and thousands of strands and struck the ground like lightning. The Transcendents who had been shooting the most powerful magic groaned and fell to the ground.

"Shoot again!"

But the Transcendents were persistent. Each and every one of them had entered 'transcendence' after intense training. They would not back down from such a small blow.

[It’s annoying.]

Apollo snapped his fingers in the air, and a huge wall rose up around the ark.

[The story, 'Walls of Troy', begins!]

It was once a wall built by Apollo and Poseidon to protect Troy.

The Transcendents groaned at the thickness of the wall, which could even repel the powerful Mashi with enormous destructive power.

"How could this—"

This was the history built by the Twelve Constellations.

Apollo's sun, burning brightly above the wall, looked down on the bewildered humanity.

[Foolish humans. You can't win…]

[That obvious threat pattern hasn't changed for hundreds of years.]

Apollo stepped back in shock at the words of advice he heard right next to him.

When did it start? Cheok Jungyeong was standing right next to him.

[Shut up!]

A furious Apollo once again let go of his bow.

As Cheok Jungyeong twisted his body slightly to avoid the fire, the artificial sun's intense heat poured down onto the castle walls.

Cheok Jungyeong laughed.

[This is the perfect toy to put in the introduction of that rich guy.]

Cheok Jungyeong's three swords spit fire. From the two swords to the three swords. Cheok Jungyeong's secret technique, which cut mountains and seas, split the castle walls and struck Apollo's sun.

Kudududududud!

The Historical-grade Constellations caught in the aftermath screamed.

The artificial sun, split in half, lost its light as sparks flew.

Apollo, standing in front of the shattered artificial sun, muttered in vain with soot all over his body.

[This is ridiculous… How could my sun…]

Apollo's expression showed fear for the first time. He hurriedly turned around and shouted.

[What are you all just watching? Hephaestus! Athena! Artemi—]

With a thud, Cheok Jungyeong's sword pierced his heart.

Apollo's incarnation collapsed.

At the same time, the Constellations waiting behind him, each with their own powers, rushed at Cheok Jungyeong.

[The Constellation, 'Speaker of Justice and Wisdom', reveals her own status!]

[The Constellation, 'Blacksmith of the Volcano', reveals his own status!]

[The Constellation, 'Pure Moonlight Hunter', reveals her own status!]

Three Constellations of Olympus… He deflected Artemis' arrows, blocked Hephaestus's hammer, and aimed for Athena's Aegis whenever he saw an opening.

The Constellations gaped in frustration at the fierceness of Cheok Jungyeong, who fought fiercely against three of the Twelve Divine seats.

At that moment, a Constellation appeared at the end of the broken Trojan walls. The air in the area changed slightly, and a lightning-like spell struck the battlefield.

[Olympus is in a terrible state.]

The moment the spell fell, the expressions of the Constellations and Transcendents changed. The faces of the Constellations turned gray, and the faces of the Transcendents became covered in darkness. It couldn't be otherwise. The Constellations that had just appeared were beings who could change the atmosphere of this battlefield.

If there were Twelve Divine seats in <Olympus>, there were Eight Locapalas in <Vedas>. The only 'Lokapala' who survived until the final scenario, and the only Constellation that claims to be the strongest among them.

[Children of <Olympus>. Do you need this body's help?]

Indra, the 'God King of Thunder'

Except for the Three Gods of <Vedas>, the most powerful being had just appeared at the entrance of the ark.

Indra, who had been laughing lightly with both arms spread out, landed on the bottom of the wall and asked.

[Is there a human who dares to face me?]

He was confident that there would be no being who could face the God King of Thunder, not even another Constellation.

However, there was a Transcendent that had been waiting for him to come forward.

Indra looked at the Transcendent that was the size of a fist in front of him.

[What is this little rat?]

However, when that little rat pulled out his sword, Indra was unconsciously taking a battle stance. Indra frowned in surprise.

'This body is tense?'

The smallest Transcendent in the world. He thought he had heard that name somewhere.

A dwarf from a remote planet who goes around talking crazy about how the smallest things are the greatest.

[Is that so, you.]

Second Captain of the Transcendent Alliance, Kyrgios Rodgraim, the Paradoxical White-Blue.

"Let's get started right away."

As soon as he finished speaking, the two beings' bodies disappeared. For a moment, it seemed as if everything had been turned into a vacuum, and all sounds disappeared, before a terrifying thunderbolt exploded in the air. A storm of lightning that raged on without stopping.

Every time Kyrgios' [All-in-One] and Indra's [Thunderstorm] collided, the scenery of the night sky changed.

[The Constellation, 'God of Thunderbolt', activates the stigma 'Eye that Watches Over All'!]

The Constellations let out a gasp of astonishment.

The [Eye that Watches Over All]. It was the stigma that Indra used when he drew out his true power.

[Is Indra serious about that small Transcendent?]

A thousand eyes opened one by one on Indra's entire body, which had swelled up in the sky.

According to mythology, the moment all of his thousand eyes opened, Indra's incarnation could fully use the power of his true body.

It would have been suicide to give Indra time to fully manifest his power now.

However, Kyrgios waited for Indra. Indra let out a strange laugh as if he had noticed Kyrgios' feelings.

[You arrogant bastard. Do you really want to fight me?]

A thousand eyes glowed on Indra's entire body. The sacred relic, the Vajra, he had taken out spun around violently, and a [Heavenly Thunderstorm] of a different scale than before poured down. A blow that could completely destroy the surface of any planet and turn the entire area into an ocean.

In the face of that overwhelming thunder, Kyrgios stood alone.

"From the perspective of the universe, it was just a dusty incident."

With a calm voice, Kyrgios's stigma, the 'Pure White Paradox', let out a loud cry.

Baekcheong-mun.

Visionary art.

It was a technique that Kyrgios had never taught anyone. To be exact, it was the secret art of Baekcheong-mun that no one could learn.

Creation Island.

With a sound like a big bang, a dot appeared in the pitch-black thunderstorm. And in the next moment, the entire space-time collapsed around the dot.

A single flash that destroyed the rules of the sky, that flash brightly colored the entire sky, and then the light went out. Indra's dark clouds evaporated in an instant, and pitch-black rain began to fall all over the area. And.

[Oh my God.]

Indra's gigantic incarnation was revealed in the scattered raindrops. More than half of the thousand eyes that Indra boasted of were burning black or bursting.

A moment later, Indra, who had lost his balance, began to fall.

[Indra was defeated?]

The Constellations were speechless at the shocking sight of the leader of <Lokapala> being defeated.

Of course, Kyrgios was not safe either. He had to give up one of his arms to defeat Indra, who was at full power, and he suffered major injuries to his back and chest. Even so, the fact that he was able to subdue Indra with only those wounds was an absurdity.

Even if the current leaders of the Transcendent Alliance were the strongest Transcendents, it would have been difficult for them to put up such a good fight against the leader of <Lokapala>.

Nevertheless, there were two reasons why it was possible.

One was that the incarnation they possessed was the 'best body' based on the difficulty level of the 'Final Scenario'.

And the second was.

[The proficiency of all skills has greatly increased due to the effect of consuming 'Murim Dumplings'!]

A 'buff' that allows all the abilities contained in that body to be expressed to the highest level is applied.

Kyrgios looked around the battlefield.

It was to find the arrogant disciple who had gifted him this body.

How many times had he looked around?

A slender doll was seen running towards somewhere beyond the pouring meteors.

Before he knew it, Cheok Jungyeong, who was standing next to Kyrgios, was also looking at the same scenery.

"He really is a strange guy. Isn't he?"

"The one person who created this miraculous scenery where all of humanity gathered to fight against the Constellations in the night sky."

His disciple was finally entering the ark to confirm the conclusion of this 'Time Fault'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 852 Episode 46 Big Joke (3)

Anna Croft cheered up several times while watching the stars falling from the sky.

In fact, she had seen the scenery of stars falling several times, and it wasn't particularly shocking. Moreover, her dream was to make all the Constellations in the sky fall and welcome the 「Perfect Night」.

That's why she threw herself into <Asgard> and became the representative fire ship of the castle gate.

To make the Constellations fall, you have to use the power of the Constellations.

That was the answer she came up with after reading the future. Maybe that's why.

She couldn't take her eyes off the scenery of the sky now.

The destruction of the night sky without borrowing the power of the Constellations. She had never thought that she could achieve that dream with pure human power.

'Cheon Inho, is this the final chapter you dreamed of?'

The worst villain she knew.

She couldn't understand why the man who was the enemy of humanity more than anyone else did such a strange thing at the end.

"Cheon Inho."

When she called his name, the slender man on her back shuddered slightly.

Was he having a nightmare? Or was there a bad memory contained in that name?

"Cheon Inho, we're here. The ark is coming soon."

"..."

"Your plan has been completed."

A shooting star fell from the air once again. She, who was activating [Future Sight], muttered as she dodged the flying debris.

"You have to get up now. My [Future Sight] has its limits. I can't read all the futures."

"..."

"Cheon Inho."

The man still didn't move.

Anna Croft hesitated for a moment and then asked.

"Are you... really Cheon Inho?"

In fact, Anna Croft knew. This man couldn't be Cheon Inho.

The worst villain she knew couldn't be this man.

Her intuition—the 'Eyes of the Great Demon' testified to that.

So who was he? Anna Croft hesitated for a moment before opening her mouth again. It was the name the man had once told her.

"Kim Dokja."

When she called that name, the man shuddered once again. And Anna, who had called that name, bit her lips without realizing it.

Why? It was because she had a strange feeling the moment she called that name.

[Gaaaaaaaaa!]

Indra howled in the air.

Anna Croft, who suddenly came to her senses, hurriedly looked around. She saw the Constellations that had discovered them during the confusion, screaming loudly.

[They're entering the ark!]

[Don't be fooled!]

She had finally been caught. The [Future Sight] that was activating in real time was once again warning her of the danger right before her eyes.

She ran while carrying Cheon Inho. The ground exploded and arrows flying in grazed her cheeks. Sometimes, she was caught in the storm of strong energy shot by the Transcendental Constellations.

But she was a Prophet. As long as people called her a Prophet, she had to do her part. It was also a reward for the man who summoned her to this battlefield.

She ran and ran. Now, there were less than ten meters left until the ark.

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', descends to the Earth!]

And then there was a Narrative-grade Constellation blocking her way.

Dionysus, the God of Wine and Ecstasy.

The strongest of the Twelve Gods, the direct descendant of Zeus, who made her shiver just by looking at him.

The moment he stared at her, holding the bottle of wine with a languid face, the power of [Future Sight] suddenly stopped.

"Ah."

Anna Croft struggled like someone hanging from the edge of a cliff.

Just a little more.

She couldn't see the future. How could she get away from that Constellation?

[You want to go inside?]

Dionysus asked as if it were a joke. She knew he wouldn't let her in. Anna Croft nodded anyway.

[If you go in, you'll die? You know who's inside, right?]

"Still, we have to go in."

[Why?]

"Because that's the right ending for this world line."

[Really? What on earth is that 'right ending'?]

"I don't know either."

[You don't know?]

Instead of answering, Anna Croft felt the body temperature of the man hanging on her back. He was probably the only one who knew what it was.

"Cheon Inho, get up."

When was the last time she gambled with a future that she couldn't see?

"You can call me Kim Anna. Get up quickly."

Anna Croft carried Cheon Inho with one hand and pulled out her dagger with the other.

One moment is enough. She just has to use all her strength to create a single moment of emptiness. Then she might be able to throw Cheon Inho into the ark. The moment Anna Croft, who had made up her mind, summoned her strength.

"Enough with the joking."

A man in a pitch-black coat appeared behind Dionysus.

The man reached out his hand to Anna Croft, who was staggering in surprise.

"Come up."

Anna Croft blankly looked up at Yoo Joonghyuk, then hesitated and reached out her hand to him.

"You're alive, Supreme King."

Yoo Joonghyuk's large, strong hand grabbed her wrist and pulled her up onto the ark in one breath.

Anna, who was barely able to catch her breath, looked back and forth between Yoo Joonghyuk and Dionysus and asked.

"But why are you with that person? You didn't decide to side with <Olympus> now, did you?"

"Have you ever seen such a future?"

She had never seen such a future. And the man in front of her would have regressed if he had to, and he wouldn't betray his companions in such a way.

Yoo Joonghyuk glanced at Dionysus with his characteristically indifferent eyes and said.

"It's just that guy's whim."

Dionysus shrugged his shoulders and smirked as if responding to his words.

It was an incident that Anna couldn't quite understand. She knew that Dionysus was an eccentric god, but no matter what, they were Zeus's enemy.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to not care about that.

"If it's a trap, then we can just kill him then."

"You make the choice, and we'll handle it together?"

Anna Croft let out a light sigh and her heart started beating again.

She didn't know why. Was it because the agitator, the tyrant, and the Prophet had all gathered in one place?

「Maybe this moment could be a rehearsal for the ending of the 41st Round.」

Anna Croft couldn't help but think that way, even though she knew it was a somewhat unrealistic thought.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk looked at the man on her back as if he didn't care about Anna Croft's thoughts and asked.

"What happened to that guy?"

"Let's talk while we move."

"Follow me."

Yoo Joonghyuk already seemed to know where the 'Story Core' was. Maybe Dionysus had given him the relevant information.

"Is that Constellation accompanying you?"

"He won't interfere. He promised me that. More importantly, you didn't answer my question."

"Cheon Inho..."

Anna Croft added, trying her best to make her explanation sound as nonsensical as possible.

"This happened while making dumplings."

"Dumplings?"

"Do you know about the food called Murim dumplings?"

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

"How many did he make?"

"About a thousand."

Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardened. With just that explanation, Yoo Joonghyuk completely understood the situation.

"So that's why it ended up like this."

At a glance, Cheon Inho's complexion was pale. Anna Croft also looked at Cheon Inho and answered.

"He repeated the same thing all week. He made dumplings, performed [Deceased Summoning], and fed them to the survivors."

"So that's how the Transcendents became like that."

"Here, just in case, he asked me to give you one too."

Yoo Joonghyuk received a Murim dumpling from Anna. The dumpling made from memory still steamed as if it had just been made. It seemed like this was probably the thousandth dumpling he had made.

Yoo Joonghyuk asked while holding the dumpling.

"So what's his next plan?"

It was good that he brought the Transcendents, and it wasn't bad that he had infiltrated the ark.

The problem was just now. The 'Myth-grade Constellations' waiting for them inside the ark. The Narrative-grade Constellations struggling outside were strong, but if they didn't have a plan to deal with the Mythical Constellations, they had no chance of winning.

But Yoo Joonghyuk wasn't worried. That guy would have thought of a plan somehow.

"I don't know."

"What?"

"He never told me about the next plan."

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at Anna with a look of disbelief.

"I'll wake him up right now."

Yoo Joonghyuk reached out to the nape of Cheon Inho's neck, where he was sleeping, but stopped. When did it start? Dionysus, who had been following him, disappeared from sight.

Yoo Joonghyuk heard a faint warning in his ear.

[I'm sorry, but I can't help you this time. It's a bit different from when it was Hermes.]

That's when Anna Croft's eyes turned red.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

However, before she could even utter a warning, the future came rushing over them.

"Supreme King! Run away!"

Blood flowed out of her eyes as she cried out desperately.

However, even Yoo Joonghyuk couldn't move this time. He couldn't even move his heels, making resistance itself impossible. Yoo Joonghyuk knew several Constellations with this kind of presence.

And he also understood exactly who this power belonged to.

"Zeus."

The moment he mentioned that name, Yoo Joonghyuk felt as if an unprecedented power was tearing him apart.

Even Anna Croft, who was standing next to him, gasped and collapsed.

"We have to run away! Now!"

But that was not possible. For a brief moment, Yoo Joonghyuk looked back on his past lives.

He had seen Zeus's incarnation several times before. He knew very well that he was strong. He had almost died several times, and actually died several times.

But even though he had fought Zeus several times, Yoo Joonghyuk had never experienced the true power of the Constellation called 'Zeus'.

「This was a true 'Myth-grade Constellation'.」

A presence that subdued all living things.

The Myth-grade Constellation was revealing all of its presence toward the invaders of this ark. This was the power of Zeus, the apex of the three gods of Olympus, the Seat of Lightning.

[Foolish.]

The moment he heard the incantation, he felt like his breath would stop.

[You came to seek death on your own feet.]

He who had fought fiercely against the four Narrative-grade Constellations couldn't move a finger this time.

Yoo Joonghyuk realized what Zeus was trying to do with all his might.

An invisible giant hand was wrapping around his head. He felt his skull, which couldn't be opened even with a metal smelt, crack open with a crack.

Zeus was trying to open his head and take out his soul.

Kukukukukukukuku!

Yoo Joonghyuk's soul was currently in Baehu Seong's possession, and Zeus was now coveting his soul, even going against that ownership.

Using the power of other Myth-grade Constellations, he was trying to figure out his secret by consuming all the enormous probability accumulated in the Last Ark.

[Why don't you die?]

Zeus' thoughts could be heard here and there amidst the sparks of probability that were fiercely surging.

[Why do the world lines reorganize around you?]

[Dokkaebi, Constellation, incarnation, everything in this universe—]

The great question of the Myth-grade Constellation rang out in his head as if it were going to burst.

[What do they exist for?]

The next moment, the entire landscape changed.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked back at the landscape, powerlessly crouching down.

There was a snowfield there.

A vast snowfield that stretched on endlessly.

When he looked back, his footsteps were clearly visible on the snowy path.

Yoo Joonghyuk somehow felt like he knew where this place was.

This place… Yes.

This place was his inner self.

The next moment, as if pitch-black night was approaching, a giant hand's shadow fell over the center of the snowfield.

[Finally.]

Zeus's voice filled with joy.

The secret of this world was about to be revealed by the determination of the Myth-grade Constellation.

The moment when the secret contained in his soul was finally revealed to the world.

Tsutsutsutsutsut! A huge wall of strings appeared over the distant snowfield. At the same time, the shadow of a hand approaching him collided with the wall. The next moment, a violent spark exploded as if he had been electrocuted.

[The exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is strongly activated!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 853 Episode 46 Big Joke (4)

It was a plan that was carefully planned.

What would I have done if I were Kim Dokja? Or what would I have done if I were Cheon Inho?

No.

I am neither of them, so maybe I could be both.

With such an arrogant thought, I 'imagined' their strategy and created the plan.

The first step of the plan was to bring the 'Transcendent Alliance' to the Time Fault.

Introduce all the Transcendents that were revived with [Deceased Summoning] into them.

Of course, just infusing the Transcendents into their incarnation bodies wouldn't make them available right away.

Even if the Blood Demon had managed the Transcendents' bodies well, it was impossible for them to fully use their previous life's abilities after being revived.

To make up for that penalty, I started making 'Murim Dumplings'.

[The story fragment, 'Murim Dumpling Recipe', begins its storytelling!]

['Authentic Murim Dumpling' is complete!]

[Your Martial Arts Dumpling completion level is as follows.]

Completion level: ★★☆☆☆

Overall: A dumpling with a decent variety. When consumed, 'Skill Proficiency' increases.

Right after reaching a certain level of proficiency, the 'Murim Dumpling' I made had different buffs depending on its completion level.

For example, the effect of the low-grade 'Murim Dumpling' is 'Skill Proficiency Increase'.

Even though it is a low-grade product, the increase is quite large, so even if you feed them one, most Transcendents can recover a considerable level of skill.

Of course, there were some who ate several of them.

[Well done, disciple.]

They were the leaders, including Cheok Jungyeong.

They could emit dozens of times more power than other Transcendents, and they ate dozens of times more. Especially when Kyrgios ate five dumplings the size of his torso, I couldn’t help but be astonished.

"You’ve got some pretty useful skills."

I don’t know how much memory I used while making dumplings like that.

「"Writer-nim! Hehe, how have you been? It’s nothing else…"」

「"Writer-nim, I’m sorry, but this work…"」

「"Writer-nim ■■■. So here…"」

Most of what I used were the memories of the human 'Lee Hakhyun'. They're miserable, but they're the most useless memories in this world. Because they're useless, they're paradoxically the most useful memories now.

[You have completed the 'Authentic Martial Arts Dumplings'!]

I thought that if I ate the dumplings I made by trickery, my martial arts dumpling proficiency would go up, but unfortunately, that didn't happen.

Did they notice that my mind was slowly going crazy every time I made dumplings? The masters who had come back to life often spoke to me.

[Disciple, your eyes are open. And aren't they burst?]

"If you stab, your mind will become clearer. Make dumplings with the same mind as stabbing."

Although their words were not very helpful, I listened to them. I hoped that I might get a clue to transcendence.

[With this body, I might be able to test out the 'False Sword' I'm developing. By the way, what will I cut with the False Sword? Ahem, disciple. Would you like to discuss the 'False Sword' with me?]

"The smallest things are the greatest. But since big and small ultimately depend on the perception of existence, the being that can freely control that cognitive realm can be said to be the greatest."

Honestly, I didn't really understand what they were saying, but I could feel that they were trying to tell me something.

So I listened to them diligently and made dumplings.

Maybe I listened to it too much, since sometimes strange dumplings came out.

[You completed the 'Academic Martial Arts Dumplings'!]

I even tasted the dumplings as a test and collapsed.

Anna Croft said this while wiping my face, which had been suffering from a high fever all night.

"Cheon Inho. You know, but if you complete this operation, you might not be you anymore."

"Of course."

I realized it after making about 100 dumplings. Maybe by the time the story of this Fault ends, I'll have forgotten a lot about myself.

But that didn't matter.

"Original humans become no longer themselves over time."

"What do you mean?"

"Memories will disappear even if you stay still."

If memories are going to disappear anyway, wouldn't it be better to use them for something meaningful?

[Congratulations! Your proficiency in 'Murim Dumpling Recipe' has increased!]

[Congratulations! Your proficiency in 'Murim Dumpling Recipe' has increased!]

...

And so, the moment came when I revived my last incarnation with [Deceased Summoning].

Chuk Jungyeong, who was watching the summoning technique from the side, asked.

"Is it over now?"

"Yes. Except for one person."

The last target of [Deceased Summoning] was not the Transcendent Alliance's Transcendent.

Cheok Jungyeong tilted his head and asked.

"Hmm, this is my first time seeing that person?"

She is one of the strongest incarnations I know. I might fail, but I'm going to try.

I looked at her face with my eyes closed, then quietly called her name.

"Heewon-ssi."

What kind of person was Jung Heewon in the 40th Round?

Judging from the fact that she was in the Blood Demon's warehouse, she must have been a strong incarnation here too. Maybe she lived here as a 'Mad Butcher'.

Unfortunately, her soul did not respond to [Deceased Summoning].

However, I felt a strange sense of comfort just knowing that she had struggled with all her might in a place I didn't know.

So for the remaining two days, I made dumplings to feed the Transcendents.

[Congratulations! Your proficiency in 'Murim Dumpling Recipe' has increased!]

Luckily, I got a five-star rating. I also succeeded in completing the dumplings.

| |
|---|
| Completion: ★★★★★<br><br>Overall: The ultimate martial arts dumplings. |

I made them while I was in a daze, so I forgot what memories I put into them, but I thought they were okay.

I handed the last dumpling to Anna Croft, who was waiting nearby.

"Give this to Yoo Joonghyuk. He'll need it."

Anna Croft, who took the dumplings from me, asked.

"People won't know what you threw away to make these."

"So what if they don't know?"

"Why did you do this? After all, this world line is just a virtual world line restored by the 'Time Fault'."

I know that too. This world is just a virtual world line created by the 'Evil Sophist' based on his experiences.

"Because I have to show this story to the King of Fear."

"Why is that important?"

"Because that's how we can prevent the End."

"Is that all?"

I looked up at the ceiling for a moment.

[The 'King of Fear' is waiting for your story.]

A message that sounded as if it had been waiting.

I spoke as if responding to the message.

"I hope the King of Fear likes this story."

"What does it mean that he likes this story?"

"Kim Anna-ssi. Why do you think the 'Fear Realm' exists?"

"Even my [Future Sight] can't tell me that much."

Why does the 'Fear Realm' exist?

When I first came here, I thought simply.

Since the Second Kim Dokja said he likes sad things, he might have a hobby of collecting discarded materials. That's why he created this space to collect things that couldn't be told.

But is that all?

He is also Kim Dokja. Kim Dokja who loves stories the most in this world. Such a Kim Dokja would not be satisfied with simply collecting materials.

"Perhaps everything in this 'Fear Realm' is a dream that the 'King of Fear' is having."

The probability that this 'Fear Realm' is maintained is 'Second Kim Dokja' himself.

In order to maintain this huge layer of imagination, he would have to use the power of the 'Oldest Dream'.

However, he can only dream, but he can't make stories. So someone has to make stories for him.

Perhaps that must be why the 'Recorders of Fear' are gathered here.

They provide reading material for the King of Fear here, and they are receiving something in return.

If so, then so are we.

Even if this 'Time Fault' is a virtual worldline, if this world is still a dream dreamed by fragments of the 'Oldest Dream'—

"Even if this story is fake, the story we are getting could be real."

"Wait a minute, what is your plan?"

"Yes."

I answered with a grin.

"I will hunt the 'Mythical Constellations' here."

That was my second operation.

The so-called 'Mythical Constellation hunting plan'.

"However, no matter how many Transcendent Constellations you gather, if you fight them head-on, there is no chance of winning."

"I will not fight them head-on."

In order to deal with them, I have to set up a 'stage'. A place where I can become the most powerful, and a stage where they have no choice but to enter voluntarily.

「Let's lure the Mythical Constellations to Yoo Joonghyuk's 'inner self' to hunt them.」

---

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint 'Stage 3' is activated!]

[The exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is strongly activated!]

In order for this operation to succeed, at least three conditions were necessary.

「One, the Myth-grade Constellations, including Zeus, must want Yoo Joonghyuk's soul.」

This wasn't difficult.

Because I believed that Yoo Joonghyuk's [Regression] ability and the Constellations curious about the secrets of this world would definitely fall into this trap.

「Two, Yoo Joonghyuk must think of me at the right moment.」

Recalling each other is a prerequisite for activating [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

Since Yoo Joonghyuk always curses me inwardly, I believed that this condition would be no problem.

Lastly, three.

「The [Fourth Wall] I have to be able to harm the Myth-grade Constellations.」

In the end, the operation was half successful. Zeus suffered a huge shock that twisted more than 80% of his legends, but he safely escaped the [Fourth Wall].

It may have been because my [Fourth Wall] was weaker than Kim Dokja's, or maybe I underestimated the 'Myth-grade Constellation' too much.

Since the 'Dream Eater' was caught in this way, I thought it would be worth trying on Zeus too.

Still, there was some gain.

[You have achieved an unbelievable feat.]

[A new legend is sprouting for you!]

If I can just finish this scenario safely, I will be able to obtain the legend of defeating a 'Myth-grade Constellation'.

"You bastard."

I smiled at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was glaring into the air and growling.

—It's been a while.

"What on earth were you thinking...!"

—Yoo Joonghyuk, it's not over yet.

The [Fourth Wall] surrounding the surroundings dispersed, and at the same time, the snowy landscape began to disappear. Yoo Joonghyuk's consciousness returned to its original place.

The landscape of the ark appeared again in front of me, who had possessed by the guy with [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

[The Myth-grade Constellations of the ark are astonished at seeing you!]

[Some Myth-grade Constellations are shocked by the 'wall' they witnessed!]

The Myth-grade Constellations looked somewhat frightened after confirming the [Fourth Wall] I had, but Zeus, whose stories had been considerably damaged, seemed to have rolled his eyes.

[The Constellation, 'Lightning', is furious!]

[The Constellation, 'Lightning', endures the aftershock of probability and descends into the incarnation!]

The sky of the world line was going wild. The ceiling of the gigantic ark was dyed in various colors, and lightning struck the floor in a continuous stream.

[Many 'Myth-grade Constellations' advise the 'lightning Constellation' to exercise restraint!]

[Many 'Myth-grade Constellations' are curious about the identity of the 'wall'!]

[Some 'Myth-grade Constellations' warn that they should not act rashly until they find out the identity of the 'wall'!]

The problem is that Yoo Joonghyuk has not yet come to his senses.

Damn it. If this is going to happen, I have to move Yoo Joonghyuk myself—

[The character in question is refusing your control.]

No, he's refusing the 'First-Person Protagonist Point of View'? I've never heard of such a case before?

Fortunately, Yoo Joonghyuk quickly came to his senses and stood up, holding the Hwangcheon-wolguk that had fallen to the floor.

I shouted at Yoo Joonghyuk.

—Dumplings! Let's eat dumplings!

I saw the incarnation of Zeus approaching me from the opposite hallway. The incarnation of a great god made of lightning itself, so much so that just looking at it would make you lose your mind. One fortunate thing is that since he had exhausted his strength in the [Fourth Wall] earlier, the power Zeus can now exert is only this much.

However, even with this power alone, Zeus was showing strength that far surpassed Indra and Kyrgios.

That was the true god of lightning. Zeus, the king of the Twelve Gods of <Olympus>.

"I'll eat half."

—Eat it all, just like that!

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't listen. As if half a dumpling was enough to deal with Zeus right now.

[Half of the 'Ultimate Murim Dumpling' was consumed.]

A golden current began to surge through Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

"The Story Core is beyond the corridor that guy is blocking."

In other words, if he could just get past that Zeus, he could confirm the end of this scenario.

"What's the plan?"

Of course there is a plan. But will we succeed?

I took a deep, invisible breath and said.

—Yoo Joonghyuk.

Even if the content is lacking, I am also Kim Dokja. And of course, even if the number of rounds is lacking, this guy is also Yoo Joonghyuk. Even though we are lacking, we are

also Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk. So there is no way that the main characters of the main story could not do it.

—As you know, I am not good at using my body.

"I know."

—So I will leave your body to you.

"What you are saying is obvious?"

My strategy was simple.

Like Kim Dokja in the main story, I would borrow Yoo Joonghyuk's power in the text through [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins its storytelling.]

[All the stories of the 'Demon King of Salvation' respond to you!]

An unusual spark began to fly from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

Originally, to use this power, I had to control Yoo Joonghyuk's body and fight from the 'First-Person Protagonist Point of View'.

But right now, Yoo Joonghyuk is the one controlling the body.

—Become the Yoo Joonghyuk I imagine.

Slowly closing my eyes, the pages began to turn in my head.

"What?"

[Estimated the number of Rounds will be interpreted based on your reading level.]

Only once did Yoo Joonghyuk appear in the main story using the 'spear'.

Yoo Joonghyuk hesitated as he read my memories together.

"This martial art."

This was the power that Yoo Joonghyuk originally used in the '41st Round'.

—That's right.

Of course, it would have been impossible to overcome the situation with just this martial art.

However, the current Yoo Joonghyuk is the Yoo Joonghyuk who has reached the 'Final Scenario'.

What would happen if the current Yoo Joonghyuk, who is close to becoming the ultimate incarnation, uses this martial art with the Hwangcheon-wolguk?

When I thought of Yoo Joonghyuk in my head, Yoo Joonghyuk stood holding the spear as if he were reproducing my imagination.

「The specialty is the 'spear'.」

As if we were holding a spear together, at that moment, we were embedded in one story. This is the only spear technique that can be compared to [Breaking the Sky Sword] in this universe.

It is the martial art of a world that was destroyed long ago, and the strongest martial art that Yoo Joonghyuk can use now.

「Soul Killing Spear.」

Zeus came running with a thunderous storm. The great power contained in the spear shook with fierce sparks. The unbearable aftershock was already approaching. Yoo Joonghyuk, holding the spear of the Hwangcheon-moongeuk tightly, opened his mouth.

"You know that too, right?"

At that moment, I thought I knew what Yoo Joonghyuk was going to say.

"You only get one chance."

And damn it.

"Do you know that?"

At this moment, there was only one Kim Dokja who could take those words.

「I'm actually the second.」

The spear was fired, and it flew in a single trajectory.

[NOTE 1]

Or by buying Their books: [Never Give Up 1: I will save you!: James, Ena: 9798392200443: Amazon.com: Books]

If you're broke, no worries!

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: One of the original translators can be supported on their Patreon: [patreon.com/EnaJames]

# 854 Episode 46 Big Joke (5)

Strength and strength. Will and will. Stories and stories clashed.

It was a great clash of light that I had never seen before. Something flashed before my eyes, and my vision briefly blacked out and then came back.

Someone screamed. The sound of gasping for breath. The smell of something burning.

And when I opened my eyes again.

"Supreme King!"

I saw Anna Croft, who had been rolling around in the dust, reaching out her hand towards me.

What happened?

Stories poured out of Yoo Joonghyuk's mouth. I had an ominous feeling.

Damn it, did I fail?

"You succeeded."

As if he had read my mind, Yoo Joonghyuk answered calmly.

Zeus's lightning, which had spread like fog, dispersed, and an empty hole was visible in the air. The trace of the Soul Killing Spear tearing through space. Between the sparks of lightning that were flying, I saw Zeus's incarnation with one arm and side blown off.

[The Constellation, 'Seat of Lightning', received a great shock to his incarnation body!]

"Now."

With Yoo Joonghyuk's words, I released [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]. As my soul returned to my body, sparks rippled throughout my body.

With strength in my aching muscles, I staggered toward the passage on the other side.

Zeus, who had found me like that, unleashed an electric shock with his half-remaining incarnation. Yoo Joonghyuk stepped forward and blocked the electric shock. Even as his skin burned black, the guy didn't take his eyes off me.

"Go quickly! I can't hold out for long!"

Of course. Even if he was half Zeus, he was still a Myth-grade. He wasn't someone Yoo Joonghyuk could face to buy time on his own. He was even protected by the 'Giant Nebula'. Anna Croft, standing next to Yoo Joonghyuk who was swearing with bloodshot eyes, joined in.

"Go, Cheon Inho."

If Anna Croft pushed herself that far, it must mean that she could somehow hold out with [Future Sight].

I immediately activated [Way of the Wind] and started running.

—No matter what happens in the middle, just keep running until the end. There is a power room at the end of the straight line.

I believed Yoo Joonghyuk's words and ran.

Indeed, when I reached the middle of the hallway, the surrounding scenery changed and a new world unfolded.

'The Last Ark' is a stage that gathers the 'Great Tales' of each Nebula. So it was inevitable that various worldviews would be mixed up.

While running through the hallway, I ran through Tartarus of the <Underworld>, ran through the Temple of <Olympus>, and crossed Bifrost of <Asgard>.

[Chase! Catch him!]

Soon after, Constellations chasing me appeared from somewhere.

Did they break through Yoo Joonghyuk and Anna Croft?

The sound of Zeus's lightning that could be heard from afar was also gradually getting closer. For a moment, my vision flashed, and someone pushed me away and took the lightning instead.

"Go, disciple."

When on earth did they enter the ark?

Cheok Jungyeong and Kyrgios were there.

"If you're my disciple, you can run faster than that."

I nodded at Kyrgios's words.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' begins its storytelling.]

As soon as Kim Dokja's story came to me, [Bookmark] was activated in my head. I immediately put 'Kyrgios Rodgraim' in the bookmark.

「Big and small ultimately depend on the perception of existence, so the existence that can freely control that cognitive realm is the greatest.」

['Bookmark' is activated!]

[Your understanding of the person in question is considerable!]

Is it worth listening to the difficult words so far?

[Your enlightenment increases due to the effect of 'Abstruse Murim Dumplings'!]

Or, it may be the effect of the strange dumplings I ate then.

[The level of the person in question is too high to fully reproduce the skill.]

[The level of the skill being activated is forcibly adjusted.]

Kim Dokja's main skill. Baekcheong's bright light soon covered my entire body.

[The exclusive skill, 'Full Personification Lv. 10', is activated.]

[Your current physical composition is different from that of the character.]

[Your current physical composition cannot use 'Full Electrification.]

[A powerful skill penalty is eating away at your body!]

I see. [Full Electrification] is a skill that only "dwarves" can use.

However.

[Your 'status' overcomes the skill penalty!]

If the caster's 'Strength' exceeds a certain level, even non-dwarves can temporarily use [Full Personification].

Kugugugugugu!

Even with destructive power several times its original value.

[Kuaaaaak!]

The Constellations that were blocking my path fell away like moths, burning.

[What, what is that!]

Since I had already exhausted my mental power with [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], the time I could maintain [Full Electrification] was less than 10 seconds. However, I was able to move quite a distance in just those 10 seconds.

Kuduk.

Cheon Inho's knees buckled as he could not withstand the power of [Full Electrification]. The [Bookmark] disappeared. I limped on my injured knee and continued to run.

They were not swept away by the storm of [Full Electrification]. The Constellations began to rush toward me again.

I still couldn't see the power room.

What should I do? Should I use [Incite]? Or should I use [Bookmark] again? If not—

"Come to your senses. You who deceived the stars."

The man who said those words was an unexpected person. He supported me and walked about fifteen steps, then blasted the Constellations that were rushing toward me.

"If you die, the last of humanity will die too. Do you intend to make my efforts go to waste?"

He was the Blood Demon who had been resurrected by my [Deceased Summoning].

The Blood Demon's corpses that had entered the ark together rushed toward the Constellations.

Even as his arms flew away and his thighs burst, the Blood Demon did not give up and shouted.

"Go. Go and prove that humanity has survived until the end."

Then came the sound of the Blood Demon's corpses being torn apart. Lightning strikes continued to strike from the angry sky. At that moment, I thought that I could not avoid it this time.

"Evil Sophist."

This time, someone carried me. At the same time, the falling lightning lost its way and scattered.

"My ability here can only last 5 minutes."

Ye Hyunwoo, the 'Disappearing One'.

His skill of making existence disappear finally shone in the Last Scenario.

The Ten Evils that I had revived just before coming here were there.

Kyung Sein, who was guarding the path I had walked, shouting. Lee Dansu, who was setting up a trap. Kang Ilhun, who was spreading false rumors, saying, "Cheon Inho ran away in the opposite direction!"

Finally, a small door appeared at the end of the hallway.

Ye Hyunwoo, whose skill's duration had ended, put me down and said.

"It was a good thing I didn't disappear this time."

Leaving these words behind, Ye Hyunwoo fought against the Constellations with the remaining Ten Evils.

I looked at the backs of the Ten Evils for a moment.

Has Cheon Inho seen the same scenery as me? What is the guy who pushed me into this Fault thinking as he reads this story?

Soon, the cold handle felt in my hand.

[The 'Myth-grade Constellations' belonging to the final ark are astonished!]

The ecstatic smell of stories is felt as soon as the door is opened. The 'power source' that condensed the most dazzling stories of this world line was glowing yellow in the center of the room. It was the 'Story Core' that I had been looking for.

Without hesitation, I reached out to the Story Core.

[You have acquired the 'Story Core'.]

If I destroy this, the Last Scenario will end.

[Some 'Myth-grade Constellations' try to persuade you!]

[The Giant Nebula, <Asgard>, wants to offer you a chance to 'board the ark'!]

[The Giant Nebula, <Vedas>, offers you a piece of <Locapala>!]

…

The messages from the Myth-grade Constellations surged into my head.

"If I was going to stop here, I wouldn't have even started."

[Many 'Myth-grade Constellations' say that if you don’t stop right now…!]

I struck the Story Core with all my might. Perhaps because it was a condensed story, the core didn’t break easily.

I struck it, and struck it again.

The Story Core began to crack little by little.

[The Constellation, 'Lightning Seat', spews out his terrifying rage at you!]

Zeus's lightning bolt belatedly pierced through the engine room and exploded.

I laughed even as I felt the pain of my body burning.

"It’s too late, you son of a bitch."

The moment I struck the core for the last time, there was a sound of something breaking. The enormous story that the Constellations had gathered to cross world lines was released, and a pillar of light rose toward the sky.

[Someone has achieved the clear condition of the 'Last Scenario'!]

[The <Star Stream>'s probability changes drastically!]

[The entrance to the sealed wall opens!]

When I blinked again, I was in a completely different place.

A huge wall of text surrounded my eyes.

I realized where I was.

「He couldn't tell if it was his thoughts or a record written on the wall. However, what was certain was that everything he thought, said, and did was written on the wall in front of him.」

I had finally arrived.

「The 'Final Wall' was there.」

I slowly placed my hand on the wall and the [Fourth Wall] reacted.

[The Exclusive Skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

[The 'Final Wall' accepts your presence.]

My body seemed to be seeping in like a fluid, and before I knew it, I was inside the wall.

I looked around, steadying my staggering body.

A room made up of dazzlingly glowing hologram monitors. It was a room I knew, a room I had experienced well.

「The 'Dokkaebi King' was there.」

It was dozens of times the size of an average dokkaebi. No matter how I looked at it, it looked extremely obese.

I wonder what it had been eating right before I came in.

The guy who had been chewing something in his mouth turned his huge head and looked at me.

[Huh? What is it.]

The eyes of the one who had watched the 'scenarios' the longest.

I was momentarily overwhelmed by that gaze and lost my words.

The Dokkaebi King slowly got up from his seat and stood in front of me with his belly rippling, then lowered his head and began to observe me.

[How did you get here? This is not a place you are allowed to be?]

The Dokkaebi King's large fingers touched my head. Even though my body would explode if I were crushed, I couldn't move a finger.

A spark lightly shot up and an interested expression appeared on the Dokkaebi King's face.

[Look at this. This isn't a normal worldline.]

With just one finger, the Dokkaebi King seemed to understand how I existed here.

[Using real life to create elaborate fakes. How could you… I see. You.]

With a small exclamation, the Dokkaebi King nodded.

[You are a being who 'can't help but do that'.]

I tried to open my mouth somehow. I tried to ask something.

But my lips wouldn't open. As if 'this story after this has all been decided', my body didn't move at all.

As if he had guessed my state, the Dokkaebi King smiled.

[Everything is already written, and is being written at the same time. You came to confirm the 'true ending' of this world line.]

The Dokkaebi King smiled kindly and handed me a story fragment.

[This is what you were looking for. Small and amazing star.]

And the moment I held the story, the stage of the world went dark.

[You have successfully cleared all the tasks of the 'Time Fault'!]

[All the 'Recorders of Fear' sigh at your amazing interpretation.]

[The 'Recorders of Fear' are discussing your interpretation reward.]

[The 'King of Fear' rises from the throne.]

…

[■■-level Fear, the 'Final Chapter' of the 'Evil Sophist' is playing.]

The old ending of the 40th Round began to be written on the 'Final Wall'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 855 Episode 46 Big Joke (6)

Since Lee Gilyoung visited the 'Recycling Center', there has been a slight change in the routine of <Kim Dokja’s Company>.

"The 41st world line circuit is unstable. It will probably be difficult to enter directly for the time being."

"So we won't be able to visit ahjussi in the future?"

Lee Seolhwa answered Shin Yoosung's question with a dark expression.

"Since Biyoo is in the process of restoring the circuit, there will be another chance."

<Kim Dokja’s Company> has been unable to enter the 41st world line in the form of 'Possession' for the time being.

The only connected circuit is the 'Sponsor Circuit' used by Yoo Sangah.

"Sangah-ssi, please refrain from exercising your authority as a sponsor if possible."

Yoo Sangah's circuit is the only channel through which <Kim Dokja’s Company> can currently influence the 41st world line. If even this passage is blocked, <Kim Dokja’s Company> will not be able to intervene in the '41st Round' at all.

"And Joonghyuk-ssi. You shouldn't sneak near the Void Curtain again. If you do that again... Joonghyuk-ssi?"

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been by her side until a moment ago, was nowhere to be seen.

When Lee Seolhwa let out a light sigh, Yoo Sangah comforted her.

"Joonghyuk-ssi would have understood."

"Right?"

"He isn't that stupid."

Although he sometimes acts like a real fool, the two barely swallowed the gossip they knew about each other.

At that moment, the door opened and Lee Gilyoung and Lee Jihye came in. The 'kkoma Kim Dokja' was on top of Lee Gilyoung's head, and judging from his appearance, he seemed to have come from a short walk nearby.

Lee Gilyoung, who had been taking a quick look at the atmosphere, sat down on Han Sooyoung's laptop on the table and asked. "Noonas, is it serialized today?"

When Lee Seolhwa nodded, Shin Yoosung and Lee Jihye also gathered in front of the laptop.

The only hobby of <Kim Dokja's Company>, which recently lost the means to interfere with the 41st Round.

It was reading the story of the '41st Round' newly written in the manuscript file of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 left by Han Sooyoung.

"Wow, it's real. The volume has increased again."

"Is Sooyoung unnie really serializing it?"

"I don't think so. The writing style is strangely different."

"Lee Gilyoung, do you know what her writing style is?"

"Don't ignore people, Shin Yoosung."

Shin Yoosung ignored Gilyoung's words and checked the subtitle of the newly serialized story.

"A Big Joke... What does it mean?"

"Someone must have told a really funny joke."

"How stupid. Is that really true?"

As Lee Gilyeong and Shin Yoosung were bickering, Lee Jihye grabbed their shoulders and said,

"Both of you, step aside. If you're not going to read, let me read."

"You don't read novels, do you?"

"Don't I read Soooyoung unnie's novels?"

The three of them sat with a small chair between them for a while, then soon started scrolling and turning the pages.

After reading several pages like that, the three of them let out a short breath and said,

"Ah, the story of Cheon Inho will come up soon."

"But does it make sense that Cheon Inho lived this long in the 40th Round? We also went through a lot of hardship and to get over the [Final Wall]."

"It will be revealed in the next chapter."

The three of them who were mumbling glanced at each other almost simultaneously and fell silent. Even without saying anything, they could tell that they felt the same way.

「Did Dokja-ahjussi always feel this way?」

As if he had heard that thought, the kkoma Kim Dokja who was on top of Lee Gilyoung's head came down on the table and put his hand on Han Sooyoung's monitor.

A light spark flew out of the laptop.

"Huh?"

Is it an error? Suddenly, the laptop's power blinked and the document was distorted.

Shin Yoosung was surprised to find that the font of a certain character’s name was broken.

"Hey, Lee Gilyoung. What did you press?"

"What did you say? Didn’t you break it?"

"Unnie, did you see that too? The last time he pressed the keyboard, Lee Gilyoung-"

Instead of answering Shin Yoosung, Lee Jihye stared blankly down at her own hands.

Lee Jihye slowly opened her mouth.

"That’s strange. Am I already getting presbyopia?"

Lee Seolhwa asked with a bitter smile.

"What are you talking about?"

"No, isn't that... a little strange? Are my eyes dim?"

"Dim?"

At that moment, Lee Seolhwa's expression changed. Yoo Sangah also had a very serious expression on her face.

Lee Jihye, who hadn't seen their expressions yet, tilted her head and muttered.

"Something about us... doesn't it seem a little blurry? Is it an illusion?"

The laptop blinked again and a new sentence appeared.

「And so, one of the extras who had no presence finally reached the end of the world.」

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「And so, one of the extras who had no presence finally reached the end of the world.」

It was the story of a narrow-eyed man wearing a crimson coat.

「The world finally remembered his name.」

Some called him the 'Evil Sophist', and others called him the 'One Who Deceived The Stars'.

However, his real name, as given by the world, was one.

「His name is 'Cheon Inho'.」

Cheon Inho, who had cleared the Last Scenario, was almost out of breath. He had lost his right arm, his left leg showed his bone, and his cheeks were torn long enough to reveal the inside of his mouth.

Even so, he was smiling. As if smiling like that was the only way he could mock the world.

'How did I get here?'

It had truly been a long and arduous journey. If he were to explain everything that had happened during that time, it would take more than ten volumes of a historical novel.

Cheon Inho thought this and smiled bitterly.

As he slowly walked away from the crashed ark, a distant fog rolled in as if it were enveloping him.

'The Final Fog.'

Cheon Inho had also heard the name of this fog.

The fog seen in the memories of Myth-grade Constellations, the mysterious veil that envelops the area where all scenarios end. At the end of this veil, there must be a secret that the Star Stream has been hiding.

Cheon Inho walked and walked through the fog. How long had he walked like that? When he came to his senses, he realized that a huge obstacle was blocking his path.

It was a wall.

[The 'Final Wall' is looking at you.]

「The Final Wall. Cheon Inho repeated the name of the wall to himself.」

The moment he put his hand toward it, wondering what this was, the wall bounced him off with a strong spark. As if he had no right to touch it.

The moment Cheon Inho frowned and tried to say a word, a voice was heard from behind him.

[If you touch it again, you'll die this time.]

"..."

[What a strange guy. How did you get here?]

As Cheon Inho slowly turned around, a large dokkaebi looked down at him. The eyes that intuitively saw the beginning and end of a world were there. Cheon Inho looked up at his eyes and opened his mouth.

"Finally, we've met."

The dokkaebi's eyes flashed with a strangeness at the sight of him, who was not at all intimidated.

Cheon Inho added as if enjoying the strangeness.

"It's nice to meet you. The 'Dokkaebi King' of this world."

[You recognize me.]

"Wouldn't it be strange not to recognize you? Rather, you came and went in person before me and finally came to give me the final scenario reward."

[Final scenario reward?]

The Dokkaebi King rolled his large eyes as if he was wondering what that meant.

[You cleared the 'Final Scenario', didn't you?]

"Wouldn't you know since I've come this far?"

[No way...]

The Dokkaebi King hurriedly looked at Cheon Inho, examined something, and added.

[That's strange, that world line is already an 'abandoned' place?]

"Abandoned?"

[It means a world line that no one looks into, that has no value. And yet the scenarios are still continuing?]

Cheon Inho tilted his head with a puzzled smile as if he couldn’t understand that, and then asked back.

"Does it really matter whether someone looks into my story or not? I cleared all the scenarios you set."

[I can’t believe you cleared the scenarios normally.]

"If you really doubt it, why don’t you look into my stories?"

The Dokkaebi King hesitated for a moment and extended his thick finger. Soon after, Cheon Inho’s story began to be read with the tip of his thick finger.

And after a while,

[This… I can’t believe it. You…?]

The Dokkaebi King sighed with faint astonishment.

[How can you use the 'Great True Story' of the great castle gate in this way… Did you follow the 'Direct Sweep of the Oldest Dream'?]

Cheon Inho proudly spread his arms and nodded.

"I did use some tricks, but I guess you can believe that I cleared the Last Scenario now."

[Interesting, really interesting, and it's a shame, if the 'Oldest Dream' was still watching this world line...]

The Dokkaebi King was absorbed in something for a while, then looked at Cheon Inho and asked.

[What kind of reward do you want?]

"What kind of reward can you give me?"

[Anything.]

Anything.

Cheon Inho's expression filled with an inexplicable joy, as if he had been waiting for those words.

The Dokkaebi King continued to speak.

[If you want eternal life, I will give you eternal life. If you want endless wealth, I can give you endless wealth. If you want to become a god of a world, I can make it happen, and if you want to revive someone precious, I can revive them.]

"If I revive someone precious, is that person the same 'precious person' that I remember?"

[Yes. I will revive them exactly as they are in your memories.]

"That's right. Then I will just be getting a replica of the 'precious person' in my memories."

[You could think of it that way. Indeed, it's a thought worthy of someone who has come this far.]

The Dokkaebi King chuckled as if he was happy.

[Tell me what you want in return.]

"The reward I want is."

Cheon Inho took a deep breath and said.

"To get to meet 'Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk' once again."

The Dokkaebi King's expression changed subtly.

[By Supreme King, are you referring to the 'Puppet of the Oldest Dream'?]

"The Constellations also call him that."

[Why do you want to meet him again?]

"I want to fight that guy again."

[Oh, such a romantic reason.]

"And after I beat him again, I'll say this."

A strange madness spread across Cheon Inho's expression.

"Look at this, I finally made it in the world where you failed."

The Dokkaebi King looked at Cheon Inho's face for a moment.

The Dokkaebi King's expression slowly distorted. Only after a moment did Cheon Inho only realize the meaning of that expression.

The Dokkaebi King was smiling.

[Little Incarnation, you will never meet him again. He was born different from you.]

"What does that mean?"

[Hmm… yes. Since you came this far, you are qualified to confirm 'that'.]

The Dokkaebi King stared into the air for a moment as if pondering something, then snapped his fingers.

[Look.]

With a light finger snap, sentences appeared before his eyes.

「Yoo Joonghyuk thought. This round will never fail. No, it must not fail. I cannot repeat the last round again. I will not repeat that despair, that sadness. In order to do that, first…」

Cheon Inho muttered as he watched the endless story in the air.

"What is this?"

[It’s a story.]

"I know that too. What I’m asking is—"

[A story that uses him as a 'character'.]

As the Dokkaebi King lightly extended his hand, the flowing sentences quietly lingered along his hand.

[To be more precise, it could be said to be the most important 'story' in this entire universe.]

The sentences danced around the Dokkaebi King, and were soon sucked into the [Final Wall].

[All the stories of this world line exist for the completion of that 'story'.]

"What on earth is that story?"

[You originally had no right to confirm that name… Well, what does it matter? This world line was abandoned anyway.]

The Dokkaebi King smirked as if nothing would change even if the likes of Cheon Inho found out the truth.

[Now, this is the truth of the universe you've been struggling to live in.]

When the Dokkaebi King's palm opened, there was a book there. A gust of wind blew from somewhere and turned the pages.

Cheon Inho began to read aloud the sentence written on the first page of the book.

"There are three ways to survive in a ruined world."

The moment he read that sentence, Cheon Inho was overcome by an inexplicable sense of discomfort. His instincts were warning him. He shouldn't read this story. It was the truth of a world he didn't need to know. Even so, Cheon Inho couldn't stop.

"I've forgotten some of them now. But one thing is certain. That is... the fact that you, who are reading this now, will survive."

Cheon Inho absentmindedly reached out and checked the title of the book. The name of the world he had lived in was written there.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 856 Episode 46 Big Joke (7)

Cheon Inho started turning the pages one by one. Even though it was his first story, he turned the pages easily.

It couldn't be otherwise.

Because the story contained all the scenarios he had experienced.

「It's a dokkaebi. Someone said that the moment it first appeared.」

The more he read, the more strange the feeling he had. Even though he knew that he had no choice but to read this story to the end, he felt like he would never be able to turn back once he finished it.

[Are you going to keep reading?]

The Dokkaebi King seemed to know that fact as well.

[After you finish reading it, you will never be able to return to the world you knew.]

"I wonder if I have a choice."

Cheon Inho answered with his characteristically squinted eyes. And then he began to read the story with his eyes even narrowed.

In the story, a man he knew well appeared.

A man who had been his rival throughout his life in this world. Only to kill him, to accomplish what he could not, Cheon Inho lived this life.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

He wanted to mock his splendid justice, and he also wanted to prove that he could see the end of this world without such a noble life.

"That's funny. How many worlds have you led to destruction just to see the ending you want?"

He turned the pages with trembling hands. Cheon Inho’s shoulders quietly shook as he watched the 'Supreme King' he knew speak, act, and live there.

—Next time, it wouldn't be bad to have the Ten Evils as colleagues.

Because of Yoo Joonghyuk's words, he revived the Ten Evils and brought them in as his colleagues. He tried to prove that what was possible in the next round was possible in this round as well. He joined hands with the Constellations, deceived and betrayed them. He endured life while enduring plausible nicknames like 'Evil Sophist' and 'The One Who Deceived the Stars.'

It's okay to be a coward.

It was okay to be called evil.

Because that was him. He thought that if he could survive to the end and achieve the final victory, it wouldn’t matter, if he could prove himself that way, it would be good.

But what is this?

"Am I in this story?"

In front of the story with the seven-letter title, Cheon Inho felt like all his past stories were crumbling from the corners.

[You are.]

He didn’t need to hear the explanation from the Dokkaebi King. Because the moment he turned the page, his name appeared there.

「"I see. My name is Cheon Inho."」

Cheon Inho laughed.

Is this really 'me'?

What do you know about me?

How could you describe me like that, knowing who I am and what I'm thinking?

「I could see what was going on. Cheon Inho's smiling face was visible behind the people. His lips were speaking.」

'Choose.'

Will you share food and become a hero? Or will you monopolize food all by yourself and become a villain?」

"Ah, hahaha."

Is such a sloppy villain really 'me'? He turned the page over and over again, thinking that.

Finally, his eyes stopped at one sentence.

「"Huh, huh… Yes, you…"」

The guy couldn't finish his words. That was because Jung Heewon, who appeared from behind, pierced Cheon Inho's face from the crown down.」

Cheon Inho read his own death over and over again. It was a proper and accurate death.

Cheon Inho, who had been reading that sentence over and over with eyes full of disbelief, slowly raised his head.

"Is this all there is to my story?

[Yes.]

"This is not me."

[But it is you.]

"I am here."

[No, you are there.]

The Dokkaebi King spread his index and middle fingers toward the empty space. Then, a cigarette magically appeared between them.

The Dokkaebi King silently lit the cigarette and spoke.

[In this universe, only what is recorded becomes the truth. You here will not be recorded anywhere. No one wants your story, and no one wants to read it.]

The Dokkaebi King added, glancing at the book in Cheon Inho's hand.

[But that story is different. That story was chosen by the 'Oldest Dream' and was completed. Existing as a character written in that story is all the choices you have.]

"I decide how I will exist."

The Dokkaebi King looked down at Cheon Inho for a moment as if he felt sorry for him.

[Little incarnation. How much do you know about yourself? Do you remember your parents?]

"Of course, I know everything."

[Do you remember your parents?]

"You're asking the obvious. My parents—"

Cheon Inho stopped talking until that point. Why on earth couldn't he? The words that seemed like they would flow out like a stream of water stopped inside him.

「He didn't remember his parents.」

Following that, a shiver ran through his head like lightning.

And after a while, a single sentence appeared on a wall far away.

「Cheon Inho was an orphan.」

Was that his thought? Or was it a setting someone had just made up?

Cheon Inho pursed his lips in confusion.

"I don't have parents. Because I was an orphan."

[That's right.]

"Did you know?"

[Yes.]

"Because someone made me like that?"

[Yes.]

"Who is that?"

[This universe.]

Cheon Inho and the Dokkaebi King were silent for a moment. The two beings who lived different stories but were described in the same story stared at the darkness of the universe where the stars had gone out for a moment.

"Who is Kim Dokja?"

[The symbol of the 'Oldest Dream'.]

"Is he the 'main character' of this story?"

[Now the entire universe was reorganized around him.]

"What's the reason?"

[I don't know that either. I'm just a character in this story.]

"Why isn't the Supreme King the main character? How many times has that guy regressed?"

[1,864 times.]

"He acted so great to me, and then he regressed so many times before he finally got to the end?"

The Dokkaebi King did not answer.

Cheon Inho started to giggle. His laughter sounded sad, resigned, and filled with terrifying anger. Then, at one moment, Cheon Inho's laughter suddenly stopped.

"I have decided on a wish."

Cheon Inho stood up, holding the page he was reading tightly.

"I will end this universe."

[…]

"I will take revenge on the being who designed this universe, on that guy named Kim Dokja, and on the 'Oldest Dream' that dreams of this universe."

[I can't do that.]

"Didn't you say you would grant me anything?"

[Your request is beyond my ability to grant.]

"Is it okay to be just that?"

[Yes, that's all. All you and I can do is read the story to the end. And in that story, we can realize and accept how insignificant we are. You should be grateful that you have this opportunity. Most incarnations are not even given the chance to know the truth of the world.]

"Do you think I came all this way to know this truth?"

[But that's all you can know.]

"I once had a similar conversation with Hermes."

[Hermes?]

"He said that even if I reached the 'end of everything', I would never be able to see the scenery of the world I wanted. Because—"

The pages of the book were torn slightly by Cheon Inho's forceful hands.

"I'm not 'Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk'."

A tale flowed out from the torn pages of the book.

A story not written in 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.

It was Cheon Inho's own tale.

「"Hermes, what does it mean that I can't see the end of the world?"」

During the conquest of <Olympus>, Cheon Inho accidentally connected to the joint network created by <Olympus>.

There, he came face to face with the artificial intelligence that controlled the network built by <Olympus>—or perhaps a new intelligence, as it were—Hermes, the true form of the 'Master of Skywalk'.

「[That's exactly right. Evil sophist. According to my 'Big Data', you won't be able to reach the end of the world even if you clear the final scenario.]」

「"So what does that mean?"」

「"[Because it's just written that way.]"」

「"It's written?"」

「[Have you heard of something called 'Revelation'?]」

Hermes told him about the true nature of the 'Revelation'. In this world, there is a huge 'wall' with all the sentences written on it, and all the Revelation flows out from that 'wall'.

「[But the Revelation has been cut off for a while now.]」

「"It's cut off? Why?"」

「[Probably because there is no reason for the 'Revelation' to exist in this world anymore.]」

The timing of the Revelation's disappearance was after the death of the Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk. As if there was no need for any more sentences in the world where he disappeared.

「[Cheon Inho, I think this way. The Revelation is actually a complete story, and at the center of that story is 'Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk.]」

Hermes's reasoning was correct. The result was the book he was holding in his hands right now.

「"Hermes. If you help me, Olympus will be destroyed. Why did you decide to help me?"」

「[Well. Maybe… I also got bored with the 'Revelation'.]」

Cheon Inho laughed while holding the end of the world that Hermes had wanted to see so much in his hand.

"I can't admit it."

[What are you talking about?]

Instead of answering, Cheon Inho looked at the huge wall they had turned away from.

The 'Final Wall' where all the Revelation was written.

"What is beyond that 'wall'? I will go beyond the wall."

[You can't go. You are a being that 'can't' do that.]

The Dokkaebi King let out a deep sigh and said.

[I understand your feelings, but your story ends here. You are destined not to be recorded on the 'Final Wall'.]

"Is that what you decided? Or is it what is written on the 'Final Wall'?"

Cheon Inho pulled out the sword at his waist with one arm. As the [Black Heavenly Sword] with its pitch-black blade let out a strange cry, the Dokkaebi King's expression hardened.

[Do I really have to decide your end like that?]

The Dokkaebi King waved his hand lightly as if he had already read all of his stories. Then, Cheon Inho's knees magically gave up with a 'thud'.

[You can't beat me.]

Cheon Inho's specialty was 'information warfare'.

Based on a tactical strategy. So it was natural that he couldn't use any force against the 'Dokkaebi King' he was seeing for the first time.

However, at that moment, with a slap, the 'Dokkaebi King's' finger was cut off.

[How—]

When the Dokkaebi King hurriedly looked around, Cheon Inho was already gone. When he turned around, Cheon Inho was dragging his knees and had reached the 'Final Wall'. It was the application of the ability of the Ten Evils, Ye Hyunwoo, the 'Disappearing One'.

"You didn't see it properly. How did I clear the 'Final Chapter'?"

A golden light flowed out from Cheon Inho's half-opened eyes.

[Exclusive attribute, 'New Intelligence', is activating.]

New Intelligence. The sum of big data created by <Olympus>. Hermes's exclusive attribute, which collects all the data in this world and makes a kind of [Future Simulation] based on the data possible. Cheon Inho repeated countless 'simulations' using the data collected by 'new intelligence'. Just like Yoo Joonghyuk repeated regressions, he also repeated simulations a hundred, a thousand, ten thousand times in order to clear 'just once'.

In this way, Cheon Inho found the only way to clear the final chapter, and was now here.

"I don't need to fight you. Because what I want—"

Cheon Inho's palm met the wall with a sound of tsutsutsu.

"It's beyond this."

With sparks flying fiercely, Cheon Inho felt the wall pushing him away. If this continued, his entire body would be burned black. Even though he knew this fact well, Cheon Inho did not take his hand off the wall.

[The exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

"Wall. I."

Because, he was the best 'instigator' in this world.

"The sentence written on the last wall."

With that declaration, Cheon Inho felt his body being sucked into the wall. The Dokkaebi King's screams faded away, and his body, which had turned into a story, instantly seeped

into the wall.

「That's how 'Cheon Inho' became a part of the story.」

When he came to his senses again, he realized that he had entered the wall. His heart pounded, and he was out of breath with an unknown joy.

"I have come, Supreme King."

He would finally be able to meet Yoo Joonghyuk again. Or maybe he would be able to meet the being who dreamed of this damned world.

"Oldest Dream!"

But no one answered his voice. He slowly blinked his eyes and saw the surrounding scenery.

The endless snowfield spread out before his eyes.

Cheon Inho hesitated and carefully took a step. He took one step, then two.

There were no footprints left. As if he wasn't even worthy of leaving footprints in this world.

Cheon Inho quietly looked down at the snowfield and began to laugh.

"Is there really no one?"

A world of nothingness. Trapped in the margins beyond the walls where time and space do not exist, he walked through the world. He walked for a long time.

He walked for a day, two days.

Three days, four days. A week.

A month, two months.

A year. Two years. No, maybe,

「How long have I walked?」

In fact, isn't all of this a mirage? This is a world between sentences. A place where a hundred or a thousand years can pass with a single sentence.

Thinking like that, Cheon Inho,

「Everything just felt like a big joke.」

Was the Dokkaebi King right? Was this really his fate? Was this the end given to him, this terrible journey of quietly dying without being written down anywhere or remembered by anyone, just wandering around in search of a margin where he could be buried?

"Why."

Cheon Inho opened his eyes and looked up at the sky. In the midst of his deep sense of humiliation, Cheon Inho tried to say something for the last time.

"Isn't it me?"

But that was all he could say, and after saying those words, he realized that maybe that was really his desire.

Maybe he wanted to be the main character. Maybe that's why he wanted to meet the Supreme King again and make fun of this world. Maybe he wanted someone to dream of him as a villain.

So in fact.

「Maybe he also had a story he wanted to leave behind.」

The sky of the white night. It was then that a star twinkled in the distance.

The twinkling star exploded in a dazzling manner and scattered throughout the universe. How big must the star have been that the explosion could be seen from here?

But since it was so far away, that star must have exploded a long time ago.

He was already seeing the end of a star that no longer existed in the world. With that thought in mind, he vaguely reached out to the sky, and saw a few meteors flying from the direction where the star had exploded.

One of the meteors was flying straight towards Cheon Inho.

Cheon Inho was startled and took a step back. With a light noise, the meteor crashed not far from the snowfield.

Cheon Inho hurriedly approached the place where the meteor had fallen.

There was a small cradle there.

Cheon Inho knelt down and put his hand into the cradle.

「There was a newborn baby who seemed to have been born in a story.」

Cheon Inho slowly picked up the baby. Then the baby looked at him. He only received a glance, but at that moment, Cheon Inho felt his blurry self become clearer.

Only then did Cheon Inho realize who this baby was, and what he could give him.

「Thus, the 'One Who Deceived the Stars' finally reached the reward of the scenarios.」

Cheon Inho smiled and called the baby's name.

"Your name is Kim Dokja."

The baby smiled brightly.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 857 Episode 47 King of Fear (1)

I couldn't come to my senses because so many shocking memories came rushing back at once. What on earth was I looking at?

[Trait, 'Record Repairer', activates.]

[The exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

The only thing that allowed me to come to my senses was the trait and skill.

「Cheon Inho reached the 'end of the world'.」

The journeys I had seen in the '40th Round' began to be organized into sentences.

「He met the Dokkaebi King there and overcame the 'Final Wall'.」

In fact, that alone was an unbelievable achievement. Clearing the 'final scenario' in just one time, and without the help of Yoo Joonghyuk or the main characters. Even if he borrowed the power of the 'new intelligence', it was impossible.

And yet, Cheon Inho did it. Not as the main character or supporting actor, but as an extra.

What did Cheon Inho want to show?

Even without lofty ideologies or beliefs, if you have the goal of seeing the end of the scenario, did he want to show that you can do it even if you are not the main character?

What did he gain at the end of such a fierce life?

「What Cheon Inho encountered at the end of the world was a vast snowfield.」

I could tell where that place was. It was between the lines of sentences. A cold land where no story is written, where only one person's gaze exists.

Cheon Inho was the first to step there, and he discovered something at the end of that snowfield.

「Kim Dokja.」

The goosebumps running down my spine wouldn't stop.

Could it be? Was it Cheon Inho who raised 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'?

Even his memories didn't end there.

「"I see. You were abandoned here in return for loving that story so much."」

Cheon Inho's voice could be heard occasionally.

「"Don't worry. I won't abandon you."」

A blurry image flashed by. In that image, Cheon Inho was holding a child, and walking together while holding hands. It seemed like they were talking to each other.

The two looked up at the white night sky, saw falling stars, and walked while humming. Sometimes they laughed with similar expressions.

If I didn't know anything, it was a scenery that I would consider extremely beautiful.

「"Let's walk together."」

Then came the sound of sparks.

As memories became entangled, the last sentence I heard was this.

「"Until the day this world is destroyed."」

[■■Unexpected Fear, the final chapter of 'Evil Sophist' has been completed.]

[You have achieved a non-existent achievement!]

[You have acquired a new tale!]

[The <Star Stream> is incapable of determining the grade of the tale you have acquired!]

[The dokkaebis of the Management Bureau are astonished at your achievement.]

.

.

.

[The balance of the world line is shaken!]

When I came to my senses, I was sitting on the snowfield on the screen. I didn’t know why I was there. Instead, I saw familiar shoes that might explain it.

I called the name of the man without footprints.

"Cheon Inho."

I slowly raised my head, and a man with a familiar face was there.

"Did you raise 'Kim Dokja'?"

"You and he were quite the kids."

The face I had seen the most in this world. The eyes that had always met me through the screen door and the mirror were now 'really' looking at me.

When I stood up, our eye levels soon became the same.

Cheon Inho said, seeming to like that fact.

"You finally have a face that seems curious about the villain’s story."

I nodded honestly.

"I’m curious."

"Would you like to walk a little?"

We stood side by side and started walking through the snow-covered field. But since Cheon Inho's footprints were gone, when I looked back, it seemed like I had walked alone.

"The Kim Dokja you raised… is that the 'Kim Dokja' I know?"

"There are many Kim Dokjas in this worldline. The Demon King of Salvation, the Watcher of Light and Darkness, and…"

"You know who I'm talking about, right?"

Since Cheon Inho didn't answer and just laughed, I asked him as if I was teasing him.

"Is the Kim Dokja you raised the 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' that I know?"

"'Snowfield Kim Dokja'."

Cheon Inho added, seeming to find the nickname interesting.

"By any chance, when you say 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', are you referring to the 'Kim Dokja' who tore apart his own brother and dreamed of a new universe? Some call it the 49% Kim Dokja, that Kim Dokja."

It wasn't a story I wanted to hear so clearly.

Cheon Inho muttered, perhaps because my expression was funny.

"Oh, now that I think about it, you were 'one' of the 49% Kim Dokja."

"I—"

"But the Kim Dokja I raised was very different from you."

"..."

"You didn't want to be a Kim Dokja, so you were born with a different name, and you were able to receive your parents' love."

That's right. I had parents who loved me. It would be a lie if I said I had no misfortune in life, but I've never been as miserable as the 'Kim Dokjas' in the story.

"But the Kim Dokja I raised was different. He had no parents, and there was nothing to eat in this vast snowfield."

I paused for a moment and looked back at him.

"He grew up eating my stories."

Kim Dokja who grew up eating Cheon Inho's stories.

"He realized the truth of this world and understood the tragedy of this universe before any other Kim Dokja."

"Why on earth…"

"Why… Well, I don't know. I have something to say."

Cheon Inho looked up at the sky for a moment. The same sky in his memories was looking down at us.

"I only had stories like that to feed him."

"…"

"This universe made me like that, and I just raised the child as the universe made me."

There was a calm and composed voice.

I took ten deep breaths to keep myself from getting excited and opened my mouth.

"Is that your purpose? Are you using that guy to aspire for the Star Stream?"

Instead of answering, Cheon Inho walked away, leaving the house behind him. When I listened closely, he could hear him humming. It was the exact humming he had done in his memory.

"There was definitely a time when I hated everything in this universe."

"You mean not now?"

"Well, even if my current thoughts changed."

Cheon Inho seemed a little tired and exhausted as he said that.

"I wonder what that child who grew up eating my stories would be like."

"…"

"For the poor things that were left unread and abandoned, that child could destroy this entire universe."

The moment I heard those words, things came to mind.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 and its characters. And <Kim Dokja's Company>.

My heart sank.

What if Kim Dokja, raised by Cheon Inho, inherited the hatred for them?

"I won't let that happen."

"..."

"I won't let this story end in tragedy for anyone."

Cheon Inho looked back at me.

He looked as if he had been waiting for me to say that.

"Of course it should. That way, another fun 'record' will be created."

"Help me."

Cheon Inho's steps stopped for the first time at my words.

"Are you asking for help from this body right now?"

"Yes."

Cheon Inho laughed loudly. It was an exaggerated laugh that made you wonder if a person could laugh that loudly.

"Have you forgotten who I am? I am the person who tried to destroy the world. I am the person who hated 'Kim Dokja' more than anyone else and resented this universe."

"But your goal is not to make the world ruined, right?"

"..."

"You just wanted to be recognized, right?"

"..."

"Yes, you are the only person who has lived as the 'One Who Deceived the Stars' and the Evil Sophist, the Master of the Ten Evils and the Rival of the Tyrant, the one and only 'Cheon Inho'."

Cheon Inho's mouth opened slightly.

I shot back as if I was shoving my words into his mouth.

"You just wanted to be written in this story with the main character. You hoped that someone would remember that you clearly existed in this story."

I wasn't him, but I understood his sadness. There were sentiments that I clearly felt while living through the Time Fault of the 'Evil Sophist'.

There are stories even in places that are not recorded. Life definitely exists even in places that no one's eyes reach.

I lived forgetting that extremely obvious fact even though I knew it.

"I am Kim Dokja who can write."

That's why I couldn't help but say those words. Even though I knew that the existence in front of me was the worst in the world, and even though I knew that my wrist could fly off if I grabbed his hand wrong,

"I can write your story."

I thought it was a suggestion worth making. If I could just gain Cheon Inho's power here, I wouldn't be afraid of anyone I had as an enemy in the future.

Cheon Inho looked at me for a moment as if he knew what I was thinking and said.

"That's a really sweet suggestion. But I can't accept that suggestion. It's all too late."

The emotion in his tone of voice, "It's too late," was so heavy that I didn't know what to say for a moment.

It's really too late.

And he had endured the years that made it so he could only say that.

Cheon Inho, with his arms wide open, continued speaking with a deep smile on his lips.

"And the story I wanted, you 'already' made it. It was such an impressive story."

"…"

"I didn't know you'd use the Ten Evils like that. I even less knew you'd revive the Supreme King and the Prophet, and possess the other Transcendents."

"That story—"

"I really like the ending you wrote. That's why I'm going to make the ending you made 'real' from now on."

"What is that—"

"Have you forgotten? I am also a 'Recorder of Fear'."

For a moment, a belated question crossed my mind.

Now that I think about it, why is Cheon Inho here? Why isn't he with 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', but instead, has become a 'Recorder of Fear' and is trying to meet the 'King of Fear' here?

"The 'Time Fault' managed by the Recorder of Fear becomes a story at the moment of resolution and is passed on to the owner of the Fear Realm. And the owner of the Fear Realm is..."

The moment Cheon Inho raised his head and looked up at the sky, I felt goosebumps without realizing it.

"I promised to give the power to change the record of the 'Final Wall' to the 'Recorder of Fear' who recorded the Great Fear."

With a ray of light, the sky was opening.

Cheon Inho said.

"King of Fear."

The trembling continued throughout my body.

Right now, something incredible was about to happen beyond that sky.

"You have brought the story I wanted here, so now it is my turn to grant your wish."

Before I could even stop him, light covered Cheon Inho.

A message was heard in my brightly colored vision.

[The 'King of Fear' answers the 'Evil Sophist'.]

[The 'King of Fear' provides the 'Evil Sophist' with probability.]

A huge probability that could change a world.

"Yes."

Cheon Inho, who had finally obtained that probability, extended his hand toward me.

"Let's 'rewrite' the world from now on."

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 858 Episode 47 King of Fear (2)

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I will rewrite the world.

The moment I met eyes with Cheon Inho who said that, I instinctively felt that I had to get out of here. However, I had no choice.

Just as Cheon Inho, who had obtained 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, had no choice but to read the story even though he knew the tragedy that would unfold, perhaps I was the same.

[Your synchronization level with the Recorder of Fear 'Evil Sophist' is very high.]

Maybe it is because I have also experienced the history of the 40th Round. So I also became curious. As a reader before a writer, what on earth does the extra Cheon Inho 'want to rewrite'?

"Kim Dokja."

The extra who had reached the end of the world called my name, and I raised my head in response.

His voice, filled with the power of merciless [Incite], declared.

"From now on, you are me."

The last thing I saw was the footprints of the one person we had walked together with.

"I am you."

My world disappeared.

---

Anna Croft opened her eyes under the flickering lights. As the cold breath rushed in, the vivid sense of 'being alive' finally woke up her whole body.

'The Room of Time Fault.'

As she got up, the memories of the '40th Round' she had experienced until the end of the war came flooding into her head. There, she participated in the Final Scenario with Cheon Inho and the Supreme King.

'I really reached the end of the scenarios.'

Cheon Inho... No, the words of the person possessing Cheon Inho were right.

Although it was a virtual world line, that experience was real.

With this, they gained the 'experience' of seeing the end of the scenarios.

[You have acquired a new tale!]

[You have acquired a share of a new Giant Tale!]

What she acquired this time was even a 'Giant Tale'. It seems that the name of the story hasn't been decided yet due to the delay in the <Star Stream> system, but it's a huge story that was obtained after seeing the end of the 'Last Scenario'.

If there's just this story, it wouldn't be impossible to see the end again in the 41st Round.

'It was worth coming to the Fear Realm.'

The biggest achievement is that she gained a small bond to face the Constellations together.

If she could carry out the scenario with Yoo Joonhyuk and Cheon Inho in the 41st Round...

Wait a minute, where did Cheon Inho go?

She looked around but couldn't see Cheon Inho.

The last thing she remembered was the back of Cheon Inho running to the ark's power room.

Could it be that Cheon Inho failed after that? But if he had failed, there's no way she could have safely returned to the 'Time Fault Room'?

"Cheon Inho?"

The moment she unconsciously muttered the name, dozens of pillars of light rose up nearby at once.

"Ah."

The Transcendents that had possessed themselves in the 40th Round were returning. She could barely breathe a sigh of relief. As expected, that Evil Sophist had finally succeeded in seeing the end of the 40th Round.

"Big. Damn. This time, I almost got really screwed."

"That was a really great adventure."

"Are there any of you who have gained new enlightenment?"

"That guy, the end, finally got it right."

Leaving behind the Transcendents chattering loudly here and there, Anna Croft went out to look for Cheon Inho in the gaps between the incarnations.

"Cheon Inho!"

Cheon Inho was nowhere to be seen. She tried to activate [Future Sight] in case something had happened, but the skill didn't work properly.

This had happened several times before. Especially in cases where 'Cheon Inho' was deeply involved, there were many cases where the future was strangely invisible. How long had she wandered like that? Soon, a familiar back figure came into view along with the newly appeared pillar of light.

"You're safe, Cheon Inho!"

The coat was redder than before.

The villain she was looking for was there. But why? The moment she grabbed Cheon Inho's thin shoulder, Anna Croft felt the balance of the world creaking. Suddenly, she felt uneasy and dizzy. The alarm bell that something was wrong rang incessantly in her mind.

But what on earth was wrong?

The Time Fault was safely cleared, and the Fear Realm had not yet come to an end.

But why...

"This is how it felt."

Why did she feel chills all over her body when she heard his voice?

"I really miss the air."

She instinctively tried to slap Cheon Inho's shoulder. But Cheon Inho grabbed her wrist faster than she could and asked.

"Prophet. What do you see in [Future Sight]?"

"…"

"Can’t you see anything?"

"You—"

"Of course. No 'Revelation' will work on this body anymore."

Anna Croft shook his hand hard and glared.

"You… who are you?"

"Don’t you know who I am? Haven’t you been calling out to me all this time?"

Anna Croft stepped back, her lips trembling.

It gave her goosebumps.

The sense of the prophet was speaking. She had foreseen exactly who the man before her was. But Anna Croft didn’t want to admit it.

Why, why now.

"Where did he, where did he go?"

"Him? Who?"

"The spirit that was inside your body—"

Anna Croft still didn’t know his name. She didn’t know the real name of the possessed person who had given her the nickname Kim Anna.

That’s why she had no choice but to say the name everyone called him.

"What happened to Kim Dokja?"

"Kim Dokja. You finally got to say that name."

Cheon Inho let out a big laugh as if he found that fact hilarious.

"Now I'm Kim Dokja."

"What did you say?"

"Open your eyes and look carefully, Anna Croft. Nothing has changed."

Then, a story began to be heard from somewhere.

「Anna Croft felt her heart gradually becoming calmer.」

Where did that sentence come from?

Anna Croft didn't know.

「Nothing has changed. Everything has just found its original place.」

The man in front of her was Cheon Inho.

Cheon Inho's soul had simply returned to Cheon Inho's body.

"Do you remember? We agreed to live together for the 41st Round. I came to keep that promise. You're doing well, and I'll help you do it."

It was just as Cheon Inho said. She just had to keep doing what she was going to do. She had to clear the scenario and fight the Constellations. That would be fine, but why.

"I—"

Anna Croft felt her vision waver without her knowing it.

Cheon Inho's expression became subtle upon seeing her.

The moment Cheon Inho tried to speak to her again, a voice with an unusual sense of authority was heard.

[Who are you?]

When she turned her head, Cheok Jungyeong was standing there.

[Where did my disciple go?]

The moment she heard Cheok Jungyeong's voice, Anna Croft's expression brightened. Maybe, if it was Cheok Jungyeong.

"You don't even recognize your disciple's face anymore?"

When Cheon Inho answered with his characteristically sly tone, Cheok Jungyeong approached him with brisk strides.

[You.]

His huge hand grabbed Cheon Inho's shoulder so tightly that it crushed it.

[You're not my disciple.]

An enormous sense of pressure began to weigh down Cheon Inho. A Constellation of the highest level, a Transcendental Constellation. It was the rank of the Third Division Captain of the Transcendent Alliance.

Surprisingly, Cheon Inho accepted the pressure without even batting an eyelash.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins its storytelling.]

The power of the story flowing out from his entire body was protecting him.

"This is difficult, Master."

Cheok Jungyeong, who was startled, expressed his status even more strongly, but the power of the story flowing out from Cheon Inho's entire body gradually began to grow as if to oppose Cheok Jungyeong.

There were a couple of earthquakes that shook the entire area, and the sparks flying out obscured the surrounding vision.

When the sparks disappeared along with the dust, an amazing sight unfolded there.

Third Division Captain Cheok Jungyeong was kneeling in front of Cheon Inho.

Cheon Inho, who was pressing down on Jungyeong's shoulder that was completely burnt black, looked around and said.

"Everyone, please remain quiet."

It was just a single word. At that single word, all the Transcendents were frozen and unable to move.

Anna Croft realized what kind of power Cheon Inho had just used.

「Incite.」

「Incite, which had reached its extreme, was chaining the Transcendents.」

With that, Anna Croft realized that Cheon Inho had regained his original strength from the previous Round.

Cheon Inho, the 'Evil Sophist' and the 'One Who Deceived The Stars'. Cheon Inho, who had seen the end of the world as the last human, had appeared in this 41st Round.

However, even his body was not enough to restrain all the Transcendents.

"Evil Sophist, have you regained your body?"

"God of Despair."

Chunghuh, the Commander of the Transcendent Alliance. And his escorts, Ryunard and Karlton, stood in front of Cheon Inho with a fierce aura.

Chunghuh shrugged his shoulders and said.

"I have no intention of fighting you."

"You were the one who started the trouble first, weren't you?"

"Well, I didn't do it on purpose."

Chunghuh took his hand off of Cheok Jungyeong's shoulder and touched his wrist.

Chunghuh clicked his tongue and said.

"If you've taken possession of that body, then it seems like you've achieved your goal. You should just leave this place."

"You're impatient, Commander. I haven't achieved my goal yet. And... Now is not the time for you to be stopping me."

With a thud, the door on the upper level of the Time Fault exploded.

A few panicked Transcendents stepped forward to resolve the situation.

"The door is broken!"

"Block it! If it's now, we can turn it back!"

The Outer Gods of the upper world were trying to break the Fault and cross the door.

Cheon Inho looked up at those Outer Gods and said.

"The End is not over."

The End that had been temporarily suspended while the 40th Round's story was in progress was continuing. And it was even more intense than before.

"The King of Fear is sad. Probably because he read my story."

"I'll take care of that."

"You can't enter the 'Big House', can you?"

"..."

"To stop the End, someone has to go and appease him. And right now, it seems like there's only one person here who has the qualifications to do so."

The God of Despair, Chunghuh, let out a light sigh and gave a light nod to the generals. Then, the generals made way for Cheon Inho.

Cheon Inho gave a light bow and started to climb the stairs installed in the corner of the Fault.

Chunghuh, who was watching Cheon Inho, said.

"The young man who used your body was a good friend."

"..."

"He really was a good friend."

"Is that so?"

Cheon Inho answered and turned his head to look at Anna Croft.

"Prophet, aren't you curious about the end of the Fear Realm?"

Cheon Inho smiled and extended his hand to Anna Croft, who was startled.

"Come, let's go meet the King of Fear together."

---

The books in the library were vibrating all at once. The letters fixed to the books were losing their places and popping out, and the stories over flowing from between the torn pages were flowing out.

The [Fourth Wall] was shaking.

"(This damn... Youngest! Answer me! Youngest!)"

First Kim Dokja—the Demon King of Salvation shouted while holding onto the shaking table. But no matter how many times he called, the Youngest wouldn't pick up.

It wasn't just that he wasn't picking up the phone, it was unclear whether he was alive or dead.

The name in the book in front of him was proof of that. All the spaces where the Youngest's name had been displayed had been filtered out, and now another name was trying to be written in that place.

Cheon ■ho

■ Inho

Cheon In■

…

It was clear what was happening.

He had to find the Youngest right away.

But no matter how much he shouted, his voice was just a sentence trapped in the [Fourth Wall]. It didn't reach the Youngest.

The anxious Kkoma Kim Dokjas were crying and screaming here and there. Fortunately, the Kkoma Kim Dokjas with self-esteem, including Gu Seonah, were trying to comfort them, but it was clear that if he just watched the situation like this, even the [Fourth Wall] would be destroyed.

The Kkoma Kim Dokjas' eyes looked up at him as if there was no other way.

Kim Dokjas sighed silently.

「(Guys.)」

As expected, there must be only one person who can help the Youngest right now.

So the Demon King of Salvation made up his mind.

「(Let's go outside and look around for a bit.)」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 859 Episode 47 King of Fear (3)

Cheon Inho quickly walked up the stairs.

"Wait a minute, let's go together!"

Anna Croft, who had come to her senses, followed him.

There was no one who could stop Cheon Inho now. Even Cheok Jungyeong and the commander of the Transcendent Alliance condoned him. Now, it was best to at least watch what he would do.

"What is your... purpose?"

Anna Croft couldn't help but ask, even though she knew Cheon Inho wouldn't answer. But unexpectedly, Cheon Inho, who was climbing the stairs, smiled and turned around.

"My purpose is obvious, isn't it?"

Cheon Inho's purpose.

Anna Croft thought for a moment and then said.

"You hated this <Star Stream>, right?"

A man who hated the world of Constellations in a different way than Yoo Joonghyuk. If he had a purpose in this world, it would be only one.

"Do you intend to destroy this world?"

"Similar."

"Why do you have to do that? Haven't you already seen the end of the scenarios? Why are you trying to bring destruction to this world line?"

"I made this decision because I saw the end of the scenarios once."

"What do you mean?"

"Let me put it this way. 'There are things that can only be preserved if this world is destroyed'."

There are things that can only be preserved if the world is destroyed?

Anna Croft tilted her head in confusion and quickly followed him. How far up did she go? Finally, the stairs ended and a small door leading to the upper floor appeared.

Anna Croft unconsciously swallowed.

There was no nameplate or explanation on the door. However, even without an explanation, it was clear where this door led.

"Is there the 'Big House' beyond this door?"

She remembered hearing an explanation from her seniors in the Transcendent Alliance.

'Big house'. The place where the master of this Fear Realm resides.

"Yes."

"Have you ever met him?"

"Strictly speaking, this is my first time."

Cheon Inho opened the door with Anna Croft.

[Entering the 'Big House'.]

When he opened the door, a wide field spread out before him. No matter how one looked at it, it was a quiet empty space in the mountains that could be used as a campsite for middle and high schools. If this place was a 'Big House', then it seemed like the meaning of the word 'house' needed to be redefined.

"Hmm. So this was the 'Big House'."

"Do you know this place?"

"I've read it."

Cheon Inho frowned exaggeratedly as if he was sorry, then smiled.

"To make a place like this a 'home'... The memories of that picnic must have been very precious to him."

Picnic?

Before she could even ask what that meant, a terrible cry was heard from the sky.

【Gooooooooo.】

When she raised her head in surprise, there was a giant dragon without a head flying by. There wasn't just one of them. There was a three-tailed snake, and there were giant babies that I had seen in the End Zone of the Fear Realm.

"Oh my god."

No matter how she looked at it, Outer Gods that were on the level of a Natural Disaster were running around here and there.

However, the Outer Gods didn't show any particular hostility toward them. It was as if they knew that they were guests here.

Cheon Inho also looked around at the Outer Gods with a calm expression and started walking.

After walking about ten or twenty steps, a chair appeared on the other side of the field. The chair was facing the opposite direction of them.

Cheon Inho looked at the chair and muttered.

"Why is there an 'Absolute Throne' here of all places!"

"The Absolute Throne?"

"That’s the 'Absolute Throne' that appeared in Korea. The funny thing is… 'he' has never sat on that chair."

As he said that and took another step forward, a strong wind blew and someone stood in front of them.

A pitch-black shadow wearing a threatening helmet was there. Cheon Inho said while looking at the shadow.

"There is an old warrior guarding the King of Fear. It is just as I heard."

Then the warrior nodded and said.

[Go back. You cannot meet the 'King of Fear'.]

"Is that Kim Dokja's will? Did he decide for himself?"

[It doesn't matter either way, but tomorrow is the day when we will not let a guy like you into our 'home'.]

The shadow clashed his huge fists together as if he would forcefully send them back if they didn't listen.

Cheon Inho waved his hand lightly as if he had no intention of fighting.

"But he must be sad."

[It's because of you.]

"I made him sad, so I have a responsibility to appease him."

[You can't do it. Get out.]

The moment the fighter's fist, which he had slowly raised, was about to come down, Cheon Inho quickly said.

"I have a sequel to the story I'll tell him."

[I know you have a long tongue. I'm sorry, but it won't work on me. Because—]

At that moment, a vibration that seemed to shake the entire space was heard.

[The 'King of Fear' allows the incarnations who cleared the ■■-level Fear 'Evil Sophist' to meet him.]

The surprised fighter raised his head and muttered.

[But…]

The fighter hesitated for a moment, then turned to the chair as if he was resentful, lowered his fist, and turned around.

In the end, as if he didn't even want to see the sight, the fighter said without even looking at Cheon Inho.

[Go away, damn it.]

Anna Croft asked as she passed by him.

"Who is that guy?"

"He's from another world line."

"If it's another world line..."

"A world line where the 'scenarios' ended. That person saw the end of the scenarios and surpassed the level of a Constellation. Just like I did."

When he looked back, the fighter was scribbling something in the air as if it was recording something. As if there was an invisible wall there.

"Is that person also a 'Recorder of Fear'?"

"No. Not everyone who clears the scenarios becomes a Recorder."

Cheon Inho added briefly after saying that.

"The story that person wants is already here."

The two walked past the fighter and to the place where the chair was.

The two stood side by side with the chair and looked at the scenery the chair was looking at.

A cliff spread out below the field.

Under that huge cliff, countless 'Time Faults' screens were spread out. It was literally a 'spectacular view' of Time Faults.

The most noticeable screen among them was the fault that Anna Croft knew well.

「[Using real life to create elaborate fakes. How could you… Oh, I see. You.]」

The screen of the '40th Round' where Anna Croft had stayed until then.

Cheon Inho, who had been staring blankly at the screen, opened his mouth.

"Do you like that story? 'King of Fear'."

Anna Croft looked around in confusion. However, there was no one who looked like the 'King of Fear' anywhere around her.

The moment she was about to ask Cheon Inho who she had greeted, a hallucination occurred as if all the lights in the house had gone out and come back on. It felt as if someone had turned all the lights in the house off and on at once.

When Anna Croft blinked her eyes feeling extremely dizzy, she was faced with a shocking scene.

"What is this."

The scenery of the area changed.

The ground that she had thought was a field was covered with squishy tentacles, and the screen on the cliff had turned into a giant eyeball. When Anna slowly turned her head with a dizzying sensation, she realized that something was sitting on the 'chair'. Her head didn't turn properly as if it had been pressed by scissors.

The 'King of Fear' was sitting on the chair covered with tentacles.

However, it was not in the shape of a 'person'. What was placed on the chair was a small pupa.

The pupa was beating like a small heart.

When Anna Croft looked at the pupa, the pupa also looked at Anna Croft.

The pupa said.

「I love things that are thrown away.」

Cheon Inho answered with a smile.

"I know."

「I love stories.」

"I know that too. That's the same for all Kim Dokjas."

「I hate being sad.」

"That's a lie. There is no Kim Dokja in this universe who loves sadness as much as you do."

「I hate being sad.」

"If even you hate sadness, there will be no Kim Dokja in this universe who will love sadness."

「I hate being sad.」

"You want to hear a happy story sometimes, too. Are you curious about the 'stories' of the 40th Round? There are quite a few happy stories left, and I can tell you if you want."

The pupa didn't answer. It was a positive silence.

Cheon Inho smiled faintly at the 'King of Fear' and continued.

"But there is one condition."

「I hate being sad.」

“Being who is more familiar with sadness than any other being in this universe.”

「I hate being sad.」

“I know what your greatest sadness is. You confined yourself here because you hated the strife between brothers, didn't you?”

「I...」

A new screen appeared on the cliff.

「I hate being sad.」

In the screen, two men wearing white coats stood.

Anna Croft knew the face of the man very well.

"Kim Dokja?"

At the same time as that question, the two Kim Dokjas swung their swords at each other.

「[You haven't forgotten, have you? You're no longer 51%.]」

「[You're not the 49% I knew, either.]」

「And the fight began.」

Anna Croft stared blankly at the screen.

Kim Dokja's story, torn into three pieces, was scattering into space.

「That day, the 'King of Fear' was born.」

She didn't know exactly what this story was about, but Anna Croft instinctively noticed something.

She was now witnessing the truth of this world.

And after a while, a man's face appeared on the screen. The filtering was on, so the man's face was hard to see, but it was a man in a white coat.

「"Second, please. I need your help. I need you to help me to end this fight."」

Then the screen changed and a snowy landscape appeared.

The man in the white coat standing there was speaking.

「"If you are really my 'brother', don't you know that helping me is the right thing to do?"」

A terrible tinnitus rang out.

Anna Croft instinctively covered her ears and sank to her seat.

The world was mourning. The Fear Realm was screaming.

Cheon Inho listened to the scream without any hesitation. Cheon Inho opened his mouth while blood was pouring out of both ears.

"I can solve that sadness. Now, I too have earned the qualification of being 'Kim Dokja'."

「Sadness」

"You don't have to choose anything."

「Sadness」

"I will dream the dream you deserved for you."

Cheon Inho took a step toward the chair and added with a smile.

"If you lend me your strength, this long fight will end. In the universe I dream of, neither the First, Second, Third, nor concepts like 49% or 51% are important."

Cheon Inho's entire body was overflowing with the power of [Incite].

"Everything in this universe will be dyed with equal 'Fear'. It will be a 'Big House' filled only with the things you loved."

The interval between the pupa's screams was getting faster and faster.

Anna Croft wanted to shout. She wanted to tell him to stop. But her mouth wouldn't open.

"I will make this entire universe a 'Fear Realm'."

At the moment when [Incite] reached its peak, Cheon Inho reached out his hand toward the pupa.

But the moment Cheon Inho's fingertips touched the surface of the pupa, his hand bounced off with a strong spark.

The 'King of Fear' had rejected him.

「No.」

"Why?"

「The story isn't over yet.」

The moment Cheon Inho, startled, turned around, a fierce flash of wind passed over his head.

Golden hair was cut into small pieces in the air.

In the distance, a man he knew well was standing.

"Cheon Inho."

A unique, heavy low voice.

The moment he heard that voice, Cheon Inho couldn't help but laugh.

"I see. The most important 'afterword' remained."

Another incarnation that had completed the main task of the 40th 'Time Fault'. Just like Cheon Inho, a man who had earned the right to face the 'King of Fear' was there, aiming his spear.

"Did you choose that spear as a reward?"

The spear that had accompanied the end of the 40th Round, 'Hwangcheon-wolguk', shone brightly in Yoo Joonghyuk's hand.

"But you know, right? Now you can't beat me."

The power of stories began to bloom throughout Cheon Inho's body. His true status, which had brought down Cheok Jungyeong and made even the leaders of the Transcendent Alliance nervous, was revealed.

"Because the result of our 'stage' has already been decided."

[The story 'King Slayer' begins its storytelling.]

Cheon Inho had already defeated Yoo Joonghyuk in the 40th Round. And in a showdown between Transcendent beings, the power of 'staging' is truly absolute.

Even so, Yoo Joonghyuk did not back down. Rather, as Cheon Inho's momentum rose, bright stories bloomed throughout Yoo Joonghyuk's body.

"If I were alone, it might be like that."

The moment Cheon Inho opened his eyes in surprise, Yoo Joonghyuk took out half a dumpling from his bosom and bit into it.

"It was good that I saved half."

At the same time, pure white wings sprouted from Yoo Joonghyuk's shoulder and popped out.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its storytelling.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 860 Episode 47 King of Fear (4)

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned while covering his pounding head.

[You ate the 'Ultimate Murim Dumplings'.]

The moment he ate the dumplings, memories exploded inside him.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."」

It wasn't his memory.

It was definitely his voice, but it wasn't his words.

「"The first form of the Myeolhon Shinchang is similar to Breaking the Sky's slash or Baekcheong's stab. In the end, all techniques are about connecting a point and a point. In the process, cutting, stabbing, and destroying something, and forming some kind of relationship. Building a story."」

Yoo Joonghyuk realized. It was the realization he had gained in 'Another Round'.

「"If you use this spear to destroy someone's soul, keep it in mind. To destroy a soul is to destroy the story of its existence, which means to return its story to nothing.」

Just listening to the story, there was a change in his head.

The enlightenment he had gained in the 40th Round was being summoned again and was becoming the driving force for transcendence. The accumulated enlightenment was changing his body.

[Your level of transcendence is rising!]

Of course, not all memories were related to transcendence.

There were also memories of slightly different forms. For example, the memory of the guy who made this 'dumpling',

「"Author-nim, but who gave you your name?"」

His head started to throb again. At the same time, the story contained in the dumpling began to envelop his entire body.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' continues its storytelling.]

'Demon King of Salvation'.

Yoo Joonghyuk had heard that name before. Clearly, the Demon King who appeared in the final battle of the 'Recycling Center' had the same name.

Is that all? The guy who appeared in the Washington Dome also had the same modifier.

The Demon King of Salvation. What on earth is the Demon King of Salvation?

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' roars!]

The story made a sound and latched onto his shoulder, transforming into a pair of wings. Despite being born from the Demon King's story, the wings were infinitely white and clean, like those of an archangel.

"Have you become an angel, Supreme King?"

Cheon Inho said as if mocking him. The guy lightly pulled out the sword he was wearing on his waist and aimed it at Yoo Joonghyuk. Then he added in a playful voice.

"Bam."

Yoo Joonghyuk reflexively lowered his head. An incredible magical wind swept past his earlobes. It seemed to be an attack using the skill of the returnee, Myung Ilsang. A

technique that focuses condensed magical power on the tip of a sword and shoots it like a flash.

Yoo Joonghyuk answered in a blank voice.

"Your skills have improved, Cheon Inho."

The flash of light cut through the cliff of the 'Big House'. The image of their last battle was rising on the cliff of the Fault that had been cut away.

A crimson coat and a black coat.

On a night when the stars were falling, the 'Supreme King' and the 'Evil Sophist' had pointed their swords at each other with the fate of the world at stake.

"I miss it already. The fight back then was truly great."

"..."

"Now, show me. What you've been through. What stories you've told me. If you want to properly unravel your memories—"

"Where is that guy?"

"That guy? Who are you talking about?"

"You probably already know. The 'Real Cheon Inho'."

The real Cheon Inho. At that expression, a crack spread across Cheon Inho's expression.

"I don't know what you're talking about. I'm Cheon Inho."

"You're not the one who carried out the scenarios with me."

The fierce [Way of the Wind] unfolded.

In an instant, Cheon Inho, who had narrowed the distance by about ten meters, swung his 'Unbreakable Faith'.

A strike containing the secret of [Way of the Wind].

Yoo Joonghyuk said as he struck the flying wind blade with his spear.

"That technique is not yours."

"I know. It belongs to the Immutar Wolf."

"No, it is the technique that 'that guy' used."

As if to refute, Cheon Inho's sword strike struck from above again. The activated 'Blade of Faith' scattered strong energy.

"That sword is not yours either."

Yoo Joonghyuk's Hwangcheon-wolguk blocked the 'Unbreakable Faith'. The golden strong energy contained in the spear and the blue strong energy contained in the sword clashed, causing the storm to expand. With a loud bang, the two bodies were simultaneously thrown away from each other.

Cheon Inho said with a smile.

"It's mine. This sword, this technique, and the stories you and this body have built together."

The stories of the two people resonated. The stories that Yoo Joonghyuk and Cheon Inho had built together were stirring.

[The 'Giant Tale' whose name has not yet been decided is stirring.]

"It was truly an incredible story. Wasn't it?"

"…"

"How did you feel about seeing the end of the scenarios together? How did it feel to become a character in the 'story I created'?"

"…"

"Were you happy? Or were you upset that your position as the 'main character' was taken away?"

Cheon Inho's swordsmanship was getting faster and faster.

Yoo Joonghyuk responded, accelerating his spear strike to match the speed.

"I don't know what you're talking about."

Yoo Joonghyuk's [Self-defense], which had reached its peak, deflected Cheon Inho's blade.

"I see that you're crazier than last time."

Yoo Jung-hyuk's transcendence was also rising. Stage 1, Stage 2, Stage 3... Yoo Joonghyuk's power, which had grown strong enough to threaten the Constellations of Narrative-grade, was reflected in his spear.

Kuaaaaaaa!

The Mysterious Soul Spear shot out, scraping the space.

Cheon Inho, who narrowly avoided the attack, asked.

"I was curious. Why on earth did you choose a spear? Your main weapon has always been a sword. The only weapon that suits you is the 'Heaven Breaking Sword'. But why —"

"I decided to end this Round with a spear."

Cheon Inho licked his lips, as if he didn't like that answer.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

"Wake up. Your weapon is the 'sword'."

A voice that contained the power of [Incite] that even brought down the Constellations of Narrative-grade. It was a command that no one could refuse.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' resists 'Incite'!]

But Yoo Joonghyuk endured the words. The story contained in the dumplings he ate made it possible.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is temporarily activated.]

Cheon Inho's eyes were filled with agitation.

"That skill—"

"Bring him back."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had closed the distance with [False Flames], swung his spear once again. The spirit of the Soul Killing Spear in the play pressed down on Cheon Inho's 'Blade of Faith'.

Cheon Inho resisted, holding the hilt with both hands.

"Forget that friend now. He has now become a part of me. He was the one who decided to see the end of this world with me, with his name and existence gone."

"That can't be. How can you be sure?"

"Because he promised."

"Promise?"

"That guy."

Again, his temples throbbed and an old memory flashed through Yoo Joonghyuk's head.

「"As long as you don't give up on life, I'll keep writing about you."」

He unconsciously repeated the words in his memory.

"He said he'd write my story."

A moment of bewilderment flashed across Cheon Inho's face. It was a brief moment of carelessness. Yoo Joonghyuk's spear moved without missing the moment. With a 'push-shuuk' sound, the spear pierced Cheon Inho's shoulder. Cheon Inho stepped back, blocking the pouring story.

"He won't be able to write any more stories. His stories are all over."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins its storytelling.]

"I know better what stories the Constellations want."

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' continues its storytelling.]

"I'm stronger than him. I'm smarter than him, and I'm more perfect than him. The better you can fool the Constellations, the more helpful it can be to you. I—"

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name'…]

With a sound of tsutsutsu, sparks flew out from Cheon Inho's entire body.

"I, Kim Dokja—"

Whew, stories poured out of his mouth. The backflowing story was collapsing inside Cheon Inho.

When Cheon Inho frowned and raised his head, the story spoke.

[The story 'Heir of the Eternal Name' laughs loudly.]

"Shut up."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', chuckles.]

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', chuckles.]

…

The story was going wild inside Cheon Inho.

Yoo Joonghyuk said as he looked at the scene.

"That guy could endure that story."

"..."

"He was a guy who struggled not to take the easy way."

Now, Yoo Joonghyuk was having a hard time realizing what that 'story' was.

The story that gave him great strength was actually the story that brought him the greatest tragedy. He always lived with that despair.

"You can't do it like that guy."

Cheon Inho swung his sword while screaming.

"I can do it too."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', continues its storytelling.]

A red light shone above Cheon Inho's eyes.

"In the end, 'the only Kim Dokja' will become this body."

The stories flowing out of Cheon Inho's entire body gathered around the guy's shoulder, and soon began to evolve into crimson wings.

A figure that truly fit the description of 'Demon King'.

The senses of the Regressor were warning him. If he didn't kill him now, there would be no chance.

Yoo Joonghyuk ran with all his might using [Jujak Shinbo].

The first form of the Mysterious Soul Spear.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk stretched out his spear. In that moment, a huge amount of magical power exploded from Cheon Inho's entire body with a loud noise. Yoo Joonghyuk rolled around on the floor as if his entire body had been bombed.

"I told you."

The Demon King, with his wings spread wide, was speaking.

[The story, 'King's Slayer', begins its storytelling.]

[「Staging」 begins.]

"You can't beat me."

In the end, the 「Staging」 effect was activated.

The one who supported Yoo Joonghyuk, who was staggering, was Anna Croft, who had been observing the situation until then.

"Supreme King, you can't do this anymore. You know what kind of being Cheon Inho is now."

Yoo Joonghyuk shook off Anna Croft and said.

"Is your [Future Sight] saying that?"

"[Future Sight] doesn't work on that guy."

"Then there's a chance."

He also knew that there was no chance. Once 'Staging' was activated, the odds of him winning were close to zero. But the reason he didn't lose hope... maybe it was the influence of the 'dumplings' he ate earlier. In fact, memories of the dumplings were still coming back to him here and there. For example, among the memories, there was also this.

「"If you fight and come across a situation where there is no answer."」

The guy in his memory said in his characteristically playful voice.

「"Think of me as 'Kim Dokja'."」

Normally, he would not have responded to such a joke. But why? Today, Yoo Joonghyuk was different. Thinking that maybe there was something strange in the dumpling, Yoo Joonghyuk repeated the name in his mind.

'Kim Dokja.'

At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk felt that his soul was connected to something.

And.

—Is the dumpling all digested?

A voice came into his head.

A voice he did not know. And yet, it was a voice that sounded infinitely familiar.

Yoo Joonghyuk asked that arrogant voice.

'Who are you?'

Then the voice answered.

—It's your friend's hyung.

'I have no friends.'

—Oh really, our Youngest only picks out things that will make him sad.

Yoo Joonghyuk thought for a moment and then replied.

'When you say 'Youngest', are you referring to the guy who possessed Cheon Inho?'

—Then, is there another Youngest?

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned silently.

He just remembered the name, and something possessed him.

There must have been something similar last time. While carrying out the 40th assignment of the 'Time Fault', 'that guy's' soul had inhabited him through a special method.

The guy had also possessed Cheon Inho's body, so he thought that perhaps he had possessed him in a similar way.

But this time, something was different.

He had clearly remembered that guy's name, so why was he possessed by a random being?

—Hey, relax! Relax and leave it to Hyung! I'll control and take care of it!

'I'll take care of my own fighting.'

—Hey, the 41st Round’s Joonghyuk is also Yoo Joonghyuk.

A voice that seemed somewhat detached but also joyful.

—But you, if you keep doing that, you’ll die.

As soon as the words left his mouth, a message came to mind.

[The 'curse' effect weakens your physical abilities!]

This 'staging' was created based on the story of him fighting 'Cheon Inho' while he was extremely weakened.

So it was natural that the 'staging' would lower his abilities.

'Help me not die.'

—What a shameless bastard.

'That guy would have done that.'

Cheon Inho was looking up at the sky with his wings spread in the distance. Yoo Joonghyuk could tell what was about to happen. Right now, Cheon Inho was trying to express the story he was most confident in.

「When all the stars close their eyes.」

When that story begins its storytelling, darkness will fall upon the world. If that happens, there's no way to defeat him.

—No, there is.

Along with Kim Dokja's voice, a message appeared in Yoo Joonghyuk's head.

['Ultimate Murim Dumpling' has been completely digested.]

As if he had been waiting for that message, Kim Dokja continued.

—If that guy really calls himself 'Kim Dokja'.

'The power of the stage is absolute. No matter how strong I become now—'

—I told you, you can win. Have you forgotten? You've killed 'Kim Dokja' before.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked up into the air with an expression that seemed to wonder what that meant.

'I've never killed that guy.'

—You probably won't have around now.

['Ultimate Martial Arts Dumpling' exclusive effect—'Prime' activates!]

—'You' in your 'prime' are different.

'Prime?'

[The story, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', begins its storytelling.]

Pages turning in his head.

「Incarnation Kim Dokja will be killed by the person he loves the most.」

「In the gaze of countless stars pouring down from the sky, the story that would kill me was approaching one sentence at a time.」

「And finally, a sword pierced my heart.」

In the overwhelming feast of stories unfolding in his head, Yoo Joonghyuk felt the power of the distant stories overlapping over his incarnation body.

「"It's a really great story. Isn't it?"」

The Demon King of Salvation said.

—Now, let's hunt the 'Demon King' once again.

['Staging' begins!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 861 Episode 47 King of Fear (5)

Stage vs. Stage.

Yoo Joonghyuk was surprised that this tactic was possible.

[The story, 'King Slayer', fumbles around in confusion!]

Is it possible to cover up a 'stage' that has already occurred with another 'stage'?

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', continues its storytelling!]

Then the voice in his head—the Demon King of Salvation snickered.

—Actually, it was my first time doing it too. I wasn't sure if it would work or not.

But it worked.

Yoo Joonghyuk could clearly feel the power of 'Staging' rising from his entire body.

「In the gaze of countless stars pouring down from the sky, the story that would kill me was approaching one sentence at a time.」

It was a story from a worldline he didn't know. In that story, Yoo Joonghyuk killed Kim Dokja. To be exact, his colleagues including him killed Kim Dokja.

"Why did this happen?"

—Are you curious?

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned as if he didn’t like it.

What he didn’t like even more was the effect of the 'Ultimate Murim Dumpling'.

In fact, the effect itself was not a problem. It was an effect that literally made the incarnation of the target that was consumed into that of the prime of its prime.

The problem was the period of the 'prime of its prime' defined by the effect.

"Why is my prime in a different worldline?"

The 'Yoo Joonghyuk' in the story was weaker than he is now. He didn’t have the strength to match the Constellations, and his proficiency in Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship wasn’t at a high level.

Even so, the 'Ultimate Murim Dumpling' chose his prime as the 'Yoo Joonghyuk' in the tale.

Kim Dokja giggled as he read Yoo Joonghyuk’s mind.

—Well, that’s because it’s the most popular tale, right?

There was no need to ask who. Probably the Constellations. And the <Star Stream>. For some reason, the Constellations of that worldline liked this story, and thus provided probability.

[The probability of another worldline strengthens your body.]

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was instantly shot out with explosive angular force, thrust his spear. Cheon Inho, surprised by the spear strike of a different path than before, stepped back. With a deafening cracking sound, the blade of 'Unbreakable Faith' shook dangerously. Cheon Inho, who had activated 'Demon King', was pushed back.

The two stories faced each other as the red and white feathers fluttered around like a dance.

[The story, 'King Slayer', continues its storytelling!]

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', continues its storytelling!]

It was as if a wolf and a leopard were biting each other. The stories contained in the spear strike and sword strike constantly clashed and growled.

Cheon Inho muttered as if he was impressed.

"I didn't know you'd bring in a 'stage' from another world line. You'd use the fact that I became Kim Dokja like this."

"..."

"Is this the wisdom of the 'Demon King of Salvation' who descended upon you?"

As expected, Cheon Inho seemed to have noticed Kim Dokja's presence.

Cheon Inho added as if warning.

"Demon King of Salvation. This world is the '41st Round'. This is not the world line you lived in."

—His tongue is getting longer because it's disadvantageous, that bastard.

"Do you think you can continue to interfere with this worldline like that? There's not much chance left for you now."

—Hey, keep pushing.

"How long do you think this <Star Stream> will tolerate your chaos? Do you want to disappear like this?"

—Ignore it. If we push him to his limit now, we'll win.

With a 'tsutsutsu', a light spark flew from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

[The connection to the exclusive skill 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is unstable.]

Cheon Inho's point was true. In fact, the [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] used by the First Kim Dokja was infinitely unstable compared to the Youngest.

That was inevitable because he was a being inside the [Fourth Wall].

In fact, it was absurd for Kim Dokja inside the [Fourth Wall] to influence the scenario like this.

Nevertheless, the reason why the impossible was possible was because,

[The probability of the 'Fourth Wall' is moving.]

It was because the wishes of the kkoma Kim Dokjas inside the [Fourth Wall] existed.

All 'kkoma Kim Dokjas' are fragments of the 'Oldest Dream' to varying degrees.

So the dream they dream together becomes a kind of powerful probability.

Of course, since they were all quite young, he couldn't tell how long that kind of concentration would last...

—It's okay, so don't worry and fight.

The First Kim Dokja said in a fierce voice.

—As long as that guy doesn’t give up on being 'Kim Dokja', this 'stage' will be valid.

Cheon Inho was an extra who had always dreamed of being the 'main character'. So he could never miss this opportunity to get his hands on the main character’s name.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', roars!]

So from Yoo Joonghyuk’s perspective, now was the crucial opportunity to kill the 'main character'.

[The story, 'King Slayer', is causing a ruckus!]

Story vs. Story. The conflicting stages began to fight each other.

Every time the stories clashed, wounds on Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk’s bodies increased.

As the situation of no victory continued, Cheon Inho’s narrow eyes narrowed even further.

[The story, 'When All the Stars Close Their Eyes', begins its storytelling!]

In the end, Cheon Inho took out another story. It was Cheon Inho’s main story for the 40th Round. 「When All The Stars Close Their Eyes」.

A pitch-black darkness began to fall like snow on the sky. Wherever the darkness fell, the light went out and the scenery collapsed.

Cheon Inho's nickname was 'The One Who Deceived the Stars'.

In the darkness where all the stars' gazes disappeared, he finally became complete.

The moment his vision was consumed by darkness, the blade grazed Yoo Joonghyuk's thigh and waist. Yoo Joonghyuk frowned as he adjusted his grip on his spear.

Yoo Joonghyuk had also suffered a crushing defeat from this story the last time they fought. Fortunately, from that experience, Yoo Joonghyuk knew how to destroy this story.

"Open your eyes. You damn Constellations."

Cheon Inho pretended to be surprised at Yoo Joonghyuk's voice.

"Oh, my, did you restore 'that story' through the Time Fault?"

Yoo Joonghyuk hadn't been just sitting around playing around during the 40th Round's Time Fault he experienced. Since his resurrection with [Deceased Summoning], Yoo Joonghyuk had been thinking about 'what kind of story' he would bring when he returned to the 41st Round.

And now, the story of the 40th Round was starting its storytelling once again in Yoo Joonghyuk's body.

[The story, 'King Who Leads the Stars', begins its storytelling.]

Yoo Joonghyuk's story, 'King Who Leads the Stars'. It was a story that burned the probability of the Constellations following him and illuminated the darkness of the world.

However, Cheon Inho opened his mouth as if he felt sorry.

"However, that 'story' only has meaning when there are Constellations following you."

"…"

"Have you forgotten, Yoo Joonghyuk, this is not the 40th Round. There is no Constellation following you."

Even the 'Fear Realm' was in an area where the Constellations' sight was blocked, and even if there was a Constellation that was on his side, there was no way it would be watching this scene right now.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke in a low voice.

"There is one."

At the same time as he said that, light flowed out from somewhere. Surprisingly, the place where the light flowed out was Cheon Inho’s body.

Cheon Inho, startled, looked down at his body and muttered.

"How…"

"That guy is also a Constellation."

As if only one light was enough, Yoo Joonghyuk aimed his spear at the light.

"I can see it well now."

Yoo Joonghyuk’s spear, thrown quickly, pierced Cheon Inho’s thigh.

Cheon Inho swung his sword while holding onto his thigh in amazement.

"It’s no use! You can never kill me with such an imperfect 'stage'!"

Sparks rippled in the air once again. The sparks were particularly focused on Yoo Joonghyuk’s 'spear', and the reason was clear.

「And finally, a single sword pierced my heart.」

In the story of the 「Demon King of Salvation」, it was not a 'spear' but a 'sword' that killed Kim Dokja. Cheon Inho, who knew the truth, said mockingly.

"If you had used the sword as I advised, this wouldn't have happened."

"If you're going to criticize the flaws of the stage, then you're the same."

[The story, 'King Slayer', stutters its storytelling.]

Cheon Inho had the body of Cheon Inho, but he was claiming the identity of 'Kim Dokja'.

Because of that, Cheon Inho's 'King Slayer' was also not able to fully display its original status.

"Cheon Inho, do you want to defeat me?"

"Of course."

"There is a way for you to defeat me."

"Oh, I want to hear a trap."

"You just have to give up being Kim Dokja."

"..."

"Why aren't you answering? Didn't you want to defeat me?"

Yoo Joonghyuk thought.

Cheon Inho must have absorbed the soul of 'that guy' in some way and become stronger.

That's how he became 'Kim Dokja'.

Then what if, on the contrary, he could make him vomit out his soul?

"Didn't you say you wanted to be the main character? Is that all you're prepared for?"

"..."

"The 'Evil Sophist' I know wasn't just that kind of person. He set up mean and wicked traps, but he wasn't a coward who hid behind the name of another being. So—"

Yoo Joonghyuk said, swinging his spear lightly to widen the distance.

"The current you isn't even 'Cheon Inho'."

"What do you know?"

A voice that gnashed his teeth.

Cheon Inho's swordsmanship was filled with anger.

"You, who were born as the main character of a story from the beginning, you who endured life with a noble and sublime purpose, what do you know about those who were not chosen?"

"I don't know. I don't want to know."

Every time a light burst out in the darkness, a story flowed from the two of them. Amidst the resonating sounds of panting, the two swung their spears and swords at each other.

Without any understanding of each other, they simply used their weapons with the purpose of killing each other.

Cheon Inho laughed.

"In the end, I will win."

It was a laugh that seemed to indicate that his goal had been achieved simply by continuing this fight.

"How long do you think the Demon King of Salvation can help you?"

The power of 『Staging』 embedded in Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body was gradually diminishing.

"The protagonist of this world line has now changed. The story that the Constellations want to see has naturally changed as well. That story cannot protect you forever."

"..."

"Yoo Joonghyuk, be my comrade now. Then I will show you the end of this world."

That was when the 'King of Fear' reacted.

A large earthquake occurred throughout the 'Big House'. In the uneasy vision, the Outer Gods of the Fear Realm cried out once again. And then something began.

[The 'King of Fear' reacts strongly to the story in front of him!]

Thunder rumbled in the sky and a huge crack appeared. At the same time, a being appeared through the crack. He was a dokkaebi special agent dispatched to the 'Fear Realm' on behalf of the 'Management Bureau'.

[Wow, what is this—]

It was Bihyung. Bihyung looked back at Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk as if he was urgently trying to figure out the situation, and soon understood his mission.

[Constellations, opening an emergency temporary channel!]

Temporary. As soon as the channel was opened, starlight began to rush in through the cracks.

[Many Constellations have confirmed the 'Fear Realm'!]

[Nebula, <Eden>, checks the inside of the 'Fear Realm'!]

[Nebula, <Asgard>, checks the inside of the 'Fear Realm'!]

[Nebula, <Olympus>, checks the inside of the 'Fear Realm'!]

…

As the inside of the 'Fear Realm' hidden behind a veil was revealed, the 'Big House' was filled with scattered starlight.

[The Constellations of the Giant Nebulae are shocked!]

[The 'King of Fear' manifests his power.]

[No Constellation can use 'indirect messages' on the channel in this area.]

As if he would not tolerate interrupting this story, the sky was covered in silence.

As countless Constellations twinkled silently, Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk aimed their spears and swords at each other.

With a sound of tsutsutsutsu, the story that had been protecting Yoo Joonghyuk finally disappeared.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', ends its storytelling.]

With that, Cheon Inho looked as if he was anticipating his victory.

"It's over now, Yoo Joonghyuk."

But the next moment, a star in the sky blinked.

It was a Constellation from <Eden>.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', stutters its storytelling.]

Then another star twinkled. This time, it was a star from <Emperor>.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', took its breath away.]

Again, another starlight twinkled. It was starlight flowing from the small and medium-sized Nebulae of the 'Absolute Evil' lineage.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', continues its storytelling.]

The story began to tell another story, emitting even brighter light than before.

Cheon Inho stared at the sky with his eyes wide open in disbelief.

There was no way.

The story that Yoo Joonghyuk was currently holding was not from this worldline. It was not a story that the Constellations of this worldline enjoyed with joy or sorrow.

"No way—"

Nevertheless, the story continued.

That meant that there were Constellations that wanted that story.

That meant that there were Constellations that wanted to reveal that story even if it meant burning themselves.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', stares at the distant sky.]

Therefore, the story continues once again.

To prove that there are still Constellations in this universe that like this story.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 862 Episode 47 King of Fear (6)

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[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', continues its storytelling.]

The story that blossomed from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body was wrapped around his spear.

「That is the essence of the Mysterious Soul Spear.」

The Mysterious Soul Spear's strong energy that surpassed the realm was concentrated in the spear.

「The King Who Leads the Stars.」

The story, whose probability of the stars liking him was added, scattered dazzling light.

"Come, Supreme King."

Cheon Inho did not back down and prepared for the final battle. His body was strengthened by [Incite]. The blue aura of [Baekcheong-ganggi] dyed Cheon Inho's entire body in the color of Baekcheong. The Constellations in the sky were shining dazzlingly.

Cheon Inho stared at the Constellations for a short moment and smiled bitterly.

Cheon Inho's expression at that moment was.

「That's your choice.」

It seemed as if he was saying that.

Soul Killing Spear.

1st form.

Annihilation Spear.

Annihilation Spear is a martial art that recognizes the enemy as a 'Story' and strikes at the essence of that story. Among them, Annihilation Spear was a technique that attacked the shell of the story.

Not too fast or too slow, like piling up gentle sentences, the precise spear strike collided with Cheon Inho's [Baekcheong-ganggi]. Cheon Inho's solid story, built up with [Incite], was pushed back little by little, and soon began to scatter into pieces.

Soul Killing Spear.

2nd form.

Extermination Spear.

Yoo Joonghyuk did not stop.

If Annihilation Spear broke the shell of a story, Extermination Spear was a technique that broke the skeleton of that story.

The blade of 'Unbreakable Faith' seemed to bend greatly, and then a story burst out from various parts of Cheon Inho's body that had received the spear strike. Even so, Cheon Inho desperately swung his sword and resisted. Lonely and desperately, Yoo Joonghyuk deflected the sword strike and continued his spear strike.

Soul Killing Spear.

3rd form.

Extinction Spear.

If the Annihilation form was a technique that broke the framework of the story, the third form, the Extinction form, was a technique that penetrated the essence of the story.

A strong spark flew from Yoo Joonghyuk's muscles that had contracted with all their might. Cheon Inho shouted as if he was making a last desperate effort. A strike that squeezed all the magical power in his body overflowed from the tip of the sword of 'Unbreakable Blade'.

The magical power that the dragon's heart emitted.

Before the third form was even ready, Yoo Joonghyuk was pushed back ten steps by a swift counterattack.

The one who stopped Yoo Joonghyuk from being pushed back was Anna Croft, who had been saving up strength.

"We must finish this, Yoo Joonghyuk." As Yoo Joonghyuk nodded, Anna Croft's magical power transmitted from his back added strength to Yoo Joonghyuk's Extinction spear.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', roars!]

[The story, 'King Slayer', roars!]

The two stories clashed at the same time to compete for a single stage.

And Yoo Joonghyuk's Extinction spear was activated.

Everything in the 'Big House' shook dangerously, and the magical waves that burst out swept through every corner of the house.

Anna Croft, who was standing near the pupa, reflexively bent down to the magical waves that surged in.

[Tsk.]

Someone stood in front of the pupa and received the magical waves that burst out as an aftershock.

It was the fighter protecting the 'Great King of Fear'.

[That's why you can't let just anyone into the house.]

Anna Croft looked around in surprise.

[The 'King of Fear' shudders.]

What was so enjoyable, the pupa was trembling in joy. No, upon closer inspection, the pupa looked like his throat was swallowing a cry. It was unclear which way it was, but this fight was definitely having some effect on the growth of the 'pupa'.

[It's over.]

The explosion disappeared along with the warrior's words. The first to appear from the scattered dust was Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had unleashed all of the techniques from the first to the third form, was in a state where his entire body was completely burned black, like a meteor that had pierced through the atmosphere. Even amidst the scattered stories, his spear was aiming at its target without wavering.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', ends its storytelling.]

Cheon Inho, who had a hole in his stomach, looked up at Yoo Joonghyuk while kneeling.

'Unbreakable Faith' rolling on the floor. His convictions were not broken, but he was defeated and the story collapsed.

"I see."

Cheon Inho laughed.

"As expected, 'my story' won't do."

The pupa shivered once more.

As the 'Big House' shook, Yoo Joonghyuk said.

"Bring that guy."

"Impossible."

Cheon Inho, who was laughing with his mouth wide open as if it would tear, added.

"Where on earth are you going to bring 'that guy' whose name has now disappeared?"

"I remember that guy's name."

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly closed his eyes.

It was uncertain whether that was 'that guy's' name. Nevertheless, the name definitely remained in the dumplings the guy gave him.

A white name that seemed like it would melt away like fluttering snowflakes.

"■■■. That's his real name."

The moment he said that name, the shell of the 'King of Fear' cracked slightly.

Cheon Inho stared blankly at Yoo Joonghyuk and blinked.

"Do you think he can show you the ending you want?"

"It's none of your business."

"The ending you want can't be seen anywhere. This world line is ultimately prepared for 'destruction'."

"We won't know until we fight to the end."

"We'll know even if we don't fight."

An old madness flowed through Cheon Inho's eyes as he grinned.

"The only thing we can decide is the method of that 'destruction'."

A tingling pain flowed through Yoo Joonghyuk's temple. He had a strong feeling that something was wrong. He felt that Cheon Inho had fallen much more easily than he had thought. There was no way that the end of that meticulous villain could be this sloppy.

Kim Dokja, who had been holding back from speaking to save on probability, added, perhaps thinking the same thing.

—Surely, that guy's real purpose...

What if Cheon Inho's purpose from the beginning wasn't to win this fight?

"The King of Fear who loves sadness more than anyone else."

Cheon Inho spoke in a bright voice, looking at the pupa.

"Are you satisfied now?"

With a sound of probability, [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] ended. He got a feeling.

—Yoo Joonghyuk! Get out of this house right now!

Yoo Joonghyuk instinctively moved while holding the spear of the 'Hwangcheon-wolguk'. He grabbed the arm of Anna Croft, who was standing there dumbly.

But where should he go? How should he escape?

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk, who was worried, activated [Annihilation Spear] to destroy space, a message rang out.

[The 'King of Fear' begins a fable.]

Cheon Inho spread his arms and smiled brightly.

"King, let's watch the end together."

Soon, a bright light burst out from the pupa. Something was about to be born.

[The 'End' begins.]

The world was dyed black.

---

I was sinking into the deep sea.

Gravity was pulling me down from beneath my feet.

Looking back, I had experienced something similar before. It was probably when I entered the 'National Palace Museum'. When I was collecting star jewels to collect the 'Death Sword', I [incited] myself as 'Kim Dokja', and I was in the same situation as now.

「If you go down here, there is an abyss.」

How did it end up like this? I think back on my memories.

I guess it was because I was [incited] by Cheon Inho. If I had activated the [Fourth Wall], could I have avoided this situation?

I probably would have.

But I wanted to know. Even if it meant risking the risk of turning off my mental barrier, I wanted to understand the character called 'Cheon Inho' a little more. I wanted to.

「"From now on, you are me, and I am you."」

I wanted to know what drove him so hard, and what the final 'record' he wanted was.

And maybe, now I know a little about him.

「Cheon Inho wanted to be 'recorded'.」

I don't know if that's a reasonable understanding of Cheon Inho. However, some of what I understood was like that. He just wanted to be recorded next to the main character. That was all he wanted.

A reason that someone might laugh at and say that was all he wanted.

But some people are born with it as a given, while others struggle their whole lives to have it. Just because they're neither the main character nor the supporting actor, just because they were made that way, maybe I understand that feeling well.

And the Second Kim Dokja — 'King of Fear' must have felt the same way.

[The 'End' begins.]

The moment I heard the message in my ear, I suddenly came to my senses. It wasn't time to stay like this. I had to get out of here little by little.

I concentrated my mind and activated the [Fourth Wall]. But the skill didn't activate.

Why? Was something wrong?

Just as I was starting to feel like I was losing my breath, something pulled me up from the surface of the water.

A very small hand.

I grabbed that small hand and came up to the surface. When I let out a breath, I was in a snowfield. It was the snowfield where I had talked to Cheon Inho. And what pulled me up was.

"Ah."

A very small Kim Dokja.

"Giyeon hyung."

It was Gihyung who had disappeared with Cheon Inho. Cheon Inho had returned Giyeon hyung to me as promised.

"Ah."

My hyung clung to my leg, probably happy to see me again. Knowing that Giyeon hyung's true nature was a bearded man, I carefully pulled him away.

"Thank goodness, you're safe."

"Ah."

"I told you not to cry like Biyoo."

"Ah."

"Thank you for saving me."

Giyeon nodded vigorously and looked up at the sky. I also looked up at the sky with Giyeon.

It was snowing. To be exact, stories fragments were falling like snow.

「The Fear Realm has opened.」

We read the sentences pouring down into the snowfield.

「"Block it! Block it from this side!"」

「"The Fear Realm's entrance has opened!"」

The shouts of the Transcendents.

There were the incarnations of the Transcendental Alliance that I knew. They were fighting against the End.

God of Despair–Chunghuh, Ryunard, Karlton, Yoo Hosung, Cheok Jeongyung, Kyrgios, Breaking the Sky Sword Siant.

All the Transcendents gathered together, fighting against the waves of Outer Gods that were flooding in.

「"Kuaaaaah!"」

「"Damn it, the Outer Gods are moving into the scenario area!"」

Every single sentence was so interesting that I felt like I could read it forever.

Sentences that make you lose your sense of reality.

The deaths of the incarnations between the sentences were distant and hazy.

When all these sentences pile up, the world will be dyed pure white. And pure white destruction will come.

We will lie between these lines and watch that destruction.

"Hyung, we can’t just watch."

Giyeon hyung looked up at me.

"It’s the world we created."

In this 'Fear Realm', the world hyung wrote and the world I wrote coexist.

"Ah."

"We wrote these characters ourselves, with our own hands."

I didn't come here to see this kind of quiet destruction. I still had sentences I wanted to write. There were lines I wanted to change.

"Ah."

Giyeon nodded as if he agreed. I held Giyeon's hand tightly and said.

"Please lend me your strength."

I can't do it alone. But if you help me, I might be able to somehow.

"Ah."

Just like that day when we wrote the story together, I might be able to create a proper ending to this world.

"Let's go together."

I started walking while carrying Giyeon.

I don't know why I'm trapped in this 'Snowfield'. I don't know why the [Fourth Wall] doesn't listen to me. However, if anyone thinks of me, if I can use [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] just once. Then I can get out of here.

I thought I could get out.

「What are you going to do when you go out?」

I'm going to stop the Apocalypse.

「How?」

I have to convince the Second Kim Dokja.

I have to ask him to stop the Apocalypse.

I got goosebumps for a moment.

The [Fourth Wall] is now broken.

So who am I talking to right now?

I slowly turned my head and saw a boy.

The dust of stories fluttering from his wings like snowflakes. The moment I smelled it, my mind became hazy.

The snow flurry that made me feel drunk if I lost my mind even for a moment.

The boy landed gracefully with his mysteriously sparkling, translucent wings spread wide.

「How?」

The Second Kim Dokja.

He was the 'King of Fear'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 863 Episode 47 King of Fear (7)

Why is the 'Second Kim Dokja' here? I didn't think long.

The 'Snowfield' is Yoo Joonghyuk's inner self.

Maybe not only 'Snowfield's Kim Dokja' but all Kim Dokjas have their own way of entering and exiting this space.

"Hello."

I greeted him first. Of course I had to greet him. I had to speak in a voice that was as affectionate, simple, and polite as possible. Because he said that the 'Second' was a sad guy.

Why am I thinking so many useless thoughts?

I felt like I would go crazy if I didn't think about this. Hair stood out in every pore of my body, and the chills running up my spine wouldn't stop. My legs were shaking so much that I felt like they would give out and collapse at any moment.

「The being in front of me is the Master of the Supreme 'Fear Realm.'」

The thought that I had to kneel dominated my mind. I felt tens of thousands of plankton wriggling in my frontal lobe. I wanted to sit before him and swear an oath.

I will swear allegiance. Great King of Fear who defines Fear. Born from the gap between understanding and incomprehensibility. Lover of existence and non-existence. Lover of light and darkness. And—

Tak.

It was the touch of a small hand that cut off the branches of my thoughts that were spreading out in a mess. As I lowered my head, Giyeon's small hand was holding mine.

I blankly looked at him, then held his hand tightly in return. Our trembling was transmitted through our large and small hands. His fear protected me.

Thank you, Giyeon.

I muttered to myself and took a deep breath. Then I slowly opened my mouth.

"I'm sure you already know about me."

Looking at the head of the Second Kim Dokja, I was finally realizing what it meant to face a Transcendent being without the [Fourth Wall].

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???' activates!]

"I am the Youngest Kim Dokja."

After [Inciting] myself, the trembling of my whole body gradually subsided.

I am Kim Dokja. I am Kim Dokja with the [Fourth Wall]. There is nothing in front of me that can harm me.

After thinking that over and over again, the distracting thoughts that had been boiling in my head gradually subsided.

I continued speaking.

"Oh, of course you are also Kim Dokja. Can I call you my Second Brother?"

The Second Kim Dokja did not answer at all. I regretted it later.

Damn it. I should have asked the First one more about the Second's tastes.

It was then that the Second Kim Dokja's pupils flashed like the compound eyes of an insect.

「How?」

I got goosebumps, but I tried not to show it. Instead, I smiled and accepted his words.

"So, what you mean by 'how' is 'how are you going to convince me not to cause the Apocalypse?'"

The Second Kim Dokja nodded his head silently. Fortunately, this level of communication is possible. If so, there is still a possibility.

I briefly considered using [Incite], but if I failed and provoked the Second's anger, there was a high possibility that everything would go wrong.

I decided to approach it the right way first.

"I will appeal to sympathy."

Second Kim Dokja tilted his head as if he did not understand the meaning of my words.

"You said you don't like being sad."

When I became one with Cheon Inho's soul, I also witnessed everything that had happened through Cheon Inho's eyes.

The Second Kim Dokja spoke clearly, 'I don't like being sad.'

I said, reaching out to the snow falling from the sky.

"If you cause the Apocalypse here, sadness will increase in this universe."

I felt the stories clinging to my fingertips. There was a voice there, desperately screaming, as if it didn't want to melt away.

「"Do you think you're going to die here? Do you think you're going to die in a place like this?"」

「"Save me! Save me. Please—"」

Most of them were voices I didn't know. But not all of them were like that.

「"Kim Dokja, where are you?"」

A familiar low voice.

There were scenes that flashed before my eyes without me asking who they were.

Killer King Cha Seongwoo and other readers.

「"Dokja-ssi, please help me."」

Kyung Sein.

「"Friend, are you okay?"」

Dansu ahjussi.

「"Author-nim."」

「"This way!"」

Ji Eunyu and Yerin.

「"Pildu ahjussi! Please take the other side!"」

「"Everyone block it! We have to defend Gwanghwamun!"」

「"Inho's group will block this side!"」

Ye Hyunwoo, Gong Pildu, and Bang Cheolsoo.

The people who endured the scenarios together were standing their ground without fail.

It seems that the door of Fear has already opened in the scenario area. Perhaps a large number of Outer Gods equivalent to a 'Natural Disaster' may have crossed over to the Korean Peninsula.

The Management Bureau may be able to buy some time using the excuse of probability, but there will be a limit to that.

After all, those guys end up making everything into a scenario.

In other words, if I can't convince the Second Kim Dokja right now, the 41st Round will end here.

"You've already been through a lot of sad things."

「...」

"You know that too, right? You've been watching all of this, haven't you?"

The Second Kim Dokja is also a 'Kim Dokja'. So he must have been reading my story here.

"They are not the <Kim Dokja's Company> that you love. But—"

I did not miss the slight change in the expression of the Second Kim Dokja at the moment when I mentioned <Kim Dokja's Company>.

"You love more than just <Kim Dokja's Company>, right? That's why you created this 'Fear Realm', right?"

The Second Kim Dokja listened to me silently.

"You wanted to trap everything that was being forgotten in the 'Time Fault', right?"

The 'Fear Realm' was the 'great sorrow' that the 'Second Kim Dokja' had collected.

The reason why the collected stories became 'Fear' was also clear.

In this Star Stream, 'Fear' soon becomes an important material for stories. War. Famine. Death. Murder… Once something is recognized as 'Fear', it does not easily disappear from the subconscious and is deeply imprinted like a brand. Second Kim Dokja made things forgotten over time into 'Fear' and preserved them in a giant formalin bottle called 'Time Fault'.

「Everything is worth remembering.」

Even though it was just a light fluttering of wings, it had a strong persuasive power.

In the story, the Outer Gods that had finally returned to the scenario were howling.

【Ooooooooooo!】

They were taking revenge on the world that had forgotten them. Even if they were still nothing more than Nameless Fears, they were fully enjoying themselves recorded in the story.

Even if it was in the form of the 'End'.

"It doesn't have to be recorded like this."

I said as if protesting.

"It doesn’t have to be the End."

The Second Kim Dokja shook his head weakly. With the fluttering of wings, the Second Kim Dokja’s body rose into the air. The small dust flowing out of his body became fables and stuck to me. Those fables spoke.

「It has to be the End.」

Perhaps that was the answer that the Second Kim Dokja came up with after watching the <Star Stream> for a very long time.

The Second Kim Dokja looked very sad as he said those words.

「If we don't bring about the end now, this universe will experience even greater sorrow.」

I couldn't figure out what he meant by 'greater sorrow'.

Suddenly, Cheon Inho's words came to mind. Cheon Inho said,

「There are things that can only be preserved if this world is destroyed.」

<Kim Dokja’s Company> and Han Sooyoung, whom I first met, had said something similar. If this world line isn't destroyed, other universes might be destroyed.

I also understand their justification a little.

"King of Fear. No, 'Watcher of Light and Darkness! Aren't you the 'Kim Dokja' who likes happy endings more than anyone else?"

Even so, I still think.

Is the ending of this world line really only 'destruction'?

[The story, 'Between the Lines of Truth and Lies', shines brightly.]

Is there no way to protect this world from destruction and other universes?

"I will stop it. Even if this world does not perish, I will prevent a greater sorrow from occurring."

「...」

"Just like you did someday."

The modifier of the 'Second Kim Dokja' is 'Watcher of Light and Darkness'.

He fought in the 'Great Battle of the Holy War' and obtained that modifier through a third choice that was neither absolute good nor absolute evil.

He is where he is now because he chose a path that no one else has taken.

"Second brother, please stop the End."

The Second Kim Dokja still did not answer. The moment his eyes once again gleamed like compound eyes, the wings behind him spread wide. Dust began to pour out from the wings. I instinctively thought that I should not touch it, but there was no space to escape.

The moment I touched the dust, my vision became blurred and my heart raced. When I opened my eyes again, I saw the back of Kim Dokja.

A white coat and a white face. A unique smiling expression. The Kim Dokja I had written, the Kim Dokja I remembered.

I unconsciously walked toward him.

When I looked closely, he was standing among people. People he liked. It was <Kim Dokja's Company>.

「That was the scenery that ■■■ had wanted to see for a long time.」

That's right. I wanted to see that. This scenery. I wanted to write that into the ending of this world. I wanted to see everyone I had made unhappy become happy again. I—

[The exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is restored!]

I coughed violently along with a feeling of my stomach turning inside out. The dust escaped from my body, and the illusions that had been before my eyes were all shattered.

['Butterfly Dream' is released!]

Within a hair's breadth, the [Fourth Wall] was restored, and the power of 'Second Kim Dokja' was shattered. When I raised my head, the Second Kim Dokja was about ten meters up in the air, spreading his wings and arms wide and scattering dust on the world.

The dust he had scattered was rising into the sky like snow falling backwards.

At that moment, I realized something important.

This was Yoo Joonghyuk's 'inner world'.

What was in front of me right now was the soul of the 'Second Kim Dokja'.

Then where was his true self right now?

「"Ah, what the hell is that?"」

The snow fluttering in the air solved my question.

Joy. Trembling. Exaltation. Joy. A storm of snow flurries mixed with all sorts of positive emotions was blowing.

In the midst of that storm, one incarnation muttered.

「"Is it an angel?"」

The snow flurry that touched my fingertips was vividly recreated. The scene of the scenario was right before my eyes. The 'King of Fear' who had finally escaped the 'Fear Realm' had revealed himself to the people.

The incarnations approached the Second Kim Dokja as if possessed, and inhaled the dust he had scattered. And—

Ooooooooooo!

The people became 'terrified'.

「"Don't get hit by the dust! If you get hit by it, you'll turn into a monster!"」

「"Damage! Everyone, run away!"」

The Fear Realm was expanding in real time. And that was the Second Kim Dokja's answer to my question.

「This 'End' is the only way to resolve the conflict in this universe.」

An opponent I couldn't communicate with.

So that was the end of my expectations for brotherly affection.

I took a deep breath and leaped into the air.

"I know why your soul is in this 'Snowfield'."

This is a place free from the constraints of probability. As long as his soul is hidden here, he can protect his soul from the external probability aftershock.

"But you're not the only one who isn't limited by probability."

Of course, even if I wasn't restricted, it was impossible for me to stop him with my current strength.

But I was 'Kim Dokja'.

And like all 'Kim Dokjas', 'Kim Dokja' never fights with his own strength.

[The exclusive skill, 'Bookmark', is activated!]

I didn't hesitate and called the character I had previously designated in the bookmark. No matter how much I thought about it, the only character who could handle 'Kim Dokja' in this situation was this 'existence'.

[Activation time: 3 minutes]

[This character is currently unmanageable for you!]

A character who couldn't be called with [Bookmark] originally.

However, I met this character at the 'Recycling Center' a while ago, and I gained a small amount of understanding of him.

[Your understanding of the character is low, and the level of the character is too high, so only a part of the skill is activated.]

A strong person who is restricted even in the 'Snowfield', where there are no restrictions on probability.

[The level of the character is too high to fully reproduce the skill level.]

I felt the Second looking down at me in surprise. He must have known which bookmark I had taken out.

「He is the boy who respects Kim Dokja more than anyone else in this universe.」

But it was already too late.

At least as long as the opponent was an 'insect', I was confident that I wouldn’t lose to Kim Dokja right now.

[Bookmark 3, 'Insect Lord Lee Gilyeong', has been activated!]

I reached out to the Second Kim Dokja without hesitation.

[The exclusive skill, 'Taming Lv.???', is activated!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 864 Episode 47 King of Fear (8)

The moment I activated the skill, my hand bounced off with a strong spark.

[Cannot tame the target!]

[Insufficient communication with the target!]

[Insufficient understanding of the target!]

Even though I was Gilyeong who cleared the Last Scenario, the target I was trying to tame right now was none other than the 'King of Fear'. A Transcendent being whose rank could not be measured at a glance.

However, there was a countermeasure.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

「Incite, which had been trained to the limit through the 40th 'Time Fault'.」

I added the power of [Strengthening Sentences] to it.

「I am Lee Gilyeong.」

Then the voice that had been fluttering in my head like an insect's wings became clearer.

「"I will save you, Dokja hyung!"」

King Lee Gilyeong.

「"I won't yield to anyone. Not even to that sooty bastard. Not even to Shin Yoosung."」

「"I'll become strong. To the point where I won't lose to anyone. Until there's no insect in the world that I can't tame."」

「"I'll tame it, and tame it again."」

There were scenes that came to mind every time the voice continued. The image of Lee Gilyeong casting [Tame] without regard to the level whenever he encountered the Insect Lord. The face of the boy who didn't give up even though he was torn by the Insect Lord's claws and bitten by its teeth.

If you think about it, taming something was like that.

Reaching out while risking my own wounds and hardening. Placing someone else's sentences on my margins.

Lee Gilyeong had been enduring that kind of life to get back just one person.

[The effect of the exclusive skill, 'Incite', affects the exclusive skill, 'Bookmark'.]

[Additional skills are activated!]

[Exclusive skill, 'Advanced Multi-species Interaction Lv.???', is activated!]

「Advanced Multi-species Interaction. Taming Scalp that increases the probability of Taming by interacting with the target.」

The moment the golden thread flowing from my fingertips touched the Second Kim Dokja, the entire Fear Realm screamed loudly.

The universe was connected.

---

There was a boy. He was a boy who loved reading books.

The boy especially liked novels, and among them, he cherished the story of a Regressor.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."」

The boy liked that line from the protagonist.

A person who proudly says his name anytime, anywhere.

He admired the protagonist who lived such a life.

"Isn't that just a lie?"

That's how the boy's friend evaluated the novel the boy was reading. It's just a lie. A nonexistent fiction.

The boy silently agreed to that.

"That may be so."

Everyone knows that a novel is fiction. But the boy reading it was definitely a living person.

The boy still remembered it clearly. Outside the wide-open window. The feeling of gravity disappearing beneath his feet. The moment he first searched for 'Ways of Survival' on the old hospital computer. The feeling of reading the first sentence absentmindedly.

"But it's still fun."

The only thing the boy could say to defend that fiction was 'fun'.

A fun story that saved his boring life.

The boy's friend pushed up his glasses and said.

"I don't even have to look at it. It's a story about a chosen protagonist who continues to profit and rise through the ranks."

The boy wanted to tell him that the protagonist of this story didn't rise through the ranks, but he couldn't. Because he wasn't Yoo Joonghyuk.

"What's fun about a story about a lucky protagonist who does well as planned?"

He wanted to say that the main character of this story wasn't that lucky, but he couldn't. After all, he wasn't Yoo Joonghyuk.

Instead, the boy said this.

"I'm having fun."

"Why? What's having fun?"

"Because I'm not the main character."

As the boy read the book, he discovered characters like himself one by one.

「"Captain, I wanted to be like you too."」

「"But I couldn't. No matter how hard I tried, I couldn't be like the Captain."」

「"But even in that kind of country, please come back again in the next Round. If you keep trying, you might become one someday."」

Although they couldn't become the main character, there were many characters who lived hard. From important supporting characters, to minor supporting characters, to extras who didn't even have names.

「"I definitely want to be of help to you in the next Round."」

Countless characters who said similar lines and died.

「"I'll definitely kill you."」

The boy liked their stories as much as the main character's. In that sense, it was fortunate for the boy that 'Ways of Survival' was a very long and rambling novel.

It was around that time that the boy began reading other novels together. Among them, there were some novels that the boy found quite interesting.

For example, a story about a man who hated regression so much that he died.

The difference was that, unlike 'Ways of Survival', that story was very short.

「All stories end in the end.」

When he realized that fact anew, the boy became afraid.

The novel he liked would end someday.

He knew it. Even so, it was not easy to accept that fact.

Although it was not 'Ways of Survival', he felt that way even more after seeing the end of another novel. The boy trembled with fear as he imagined the characters in the novels he loved dying over time.

「What if 'Ways of Survival' ends like this?」

The boy carefully imagined the ending of the story.

Will the villain meet a villainous end? Will the supporting characters find their respective roles? Will Yoo Joonghyuk finally figure out what his ■■ is?

Will they eventually be happy?

And will he, who watches them, be satisfied with that?

Only after thinking that far did the boy realize.

Maybe there is no such thing as a 'happy ending' in this story.

Isn't a happy ending an illusion that doesn't exist? In the end, isn't the ending of this story bound to be a tragedy?

「I wish this story wouldn't end.」

It's okay if today's chapter is sad. It's okay if tomorrow's chapter, and the chapter after that, are sad. If only that sadness can postpone the ending.

And so, if only he can live forever dreaming of a 'happy ending'.

[The 'King of Fear' begins to dream.]

The first 'Time Fault' was born at that very moment.

The ability to fix the coordinates of a story and make it a kind of eternity.

Stories that were not recorded or disappeared were piled up one by one in the fault.

A warehouse that stores disappearing stories. Even if this story ends, it's a place where the story will never be forgotten.

「The 'Fear Realm' originated from such a dream of Kim Dokja.」

There, the Second Kim Dokja stockpiled and stockpiled stories. Ignoring even the fight between his brothers, perhaps to avoid participating in that fight, he hid himself even more in the Time Fault, absorbed in collecting the disappearing stories.

And there was a 'fighter' who protected him.

[You were here, Kim Dokja.]

The fighter who came across the world line recognized the Second Kim Dokja at a glance, and the Second Kim Dokja also recognized who the fighter was.

The Second Kim Dokja asked.

'Can you protect me?'

[For how long?]

'Until the day I can think of a happy ending.'

[Okay. If you think of it, tell me. I want to write it on the 'wall' too.]

The Second Kim Dokja dreamed of a happy ending while collecting the sadness scattered throughout the world.

Looking at the disappearing stories, remembering the characters who died without being recorded as 'Fears', the Second Kim Dokja imagined a happy ending.

But no matter how many stories he collected and recorded, a 'happy ending' never came to mind. A 'happy ending' felt like a concept from another universe that he couldn't imagine.

Then one day, he came to visit.

【Of course. There's no way for everyone to be happy.】

He was a man with impressive narrow eyes.

【As long as the 'main character' exists.】

'Main character?'

【Everything started because of the 'main character'. This story started because there was a main character, and because there was a main character, someone got hurt and

died. Because there was a main character, someone became a supporting actor, and someone became an extra. And... because there was a main character, your brothers started fighting.】

'Sad.'

Why does a 'main character' exist in this world? Why should someone be the main character and someone not?

And yet, why does he like this story with a main character?

【There is a way not to be sad.】

'What is it?'

【Closing the 'book' that this story is written in.】

Closing the book.

The Second Kim Dokja tilted his head and asked.

'How?'

【Make the entire <Star Stream> a 'Fear'. Incorporate the entire universe into your dream.】

The man grinned, revealing his white teeth.

【Then this world will be 'fixed' forever without heading to the end.】

An eternal postponement of the end.

The Second Kim Dokja thought for a moment and said.

'If the story stops, it will also lose its meaning as to who the main character is.'

【That's right.】

'Then my brothers won't fight anymore.'

【That's right.】

The Second Kim Dokja smiled brightly.

'I will do that.'

Then the warrior asked.

[Kim Dokja. Is that really what you want?]

When the Second Kim Dokja nodded, the warrior smiled and answered.

[Yes, I understand.]

Soon, the sound of a book closing was heard.

---

I retched and was thrown out of the air. It was a very short moment, but it felt like I had vividly experienced a part of his history. Blood poured out of my mouth, and a message was heard.

[Exclusive skill, 'Taming Lv.???', failed.]

To tame someone means to share that being's emotions. To share their sadness and joy, their despair and fear.

However, the one I wanted to be with was the 'King of Fear.' A being that had been storing up emotions for years that I couldn't even measure.

[Exclusive skill, 'Multi-Cultural Communication Lv.???', is activated.]

It felt like someone was grabbing my brain with both hands and squeezing it.

Just having my mind connected would make me go crazy. My consciousness kept getting more and more confused.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is strongly activated!]

「(Come to your senses!)」

It was the voice of First Kim Dokja — 'Demon King of Salvation'.

「(If you get hit here, it's all over, Youngest.)」

I know. But there was nothing I could do. Even the trump card, 'Insect Lord Lee Gilyeong', was not working.

If things continued like this, the entire world line would become a 'Fear'.

I opened my mouth to somehow prevent that situation.

"I understand how you feel."

Now I understand why the Second Kim Dokja created the 'Fear Realm'.

"But this is not it."

I also understand where his end came from.

He will make the entire <Star Stream> into a 'Fear Realm'. If that happens, the main character will disappear from this world. Me, Yoo Joonghyuk, and the other characters will all become part of the 'Fear' and will be stuffed forever as a legend in the Fault.

Then the fighting will stop.

But that will stop this story forever. No one will know the ending of the story covered in thick binding.

"You liked this story, right?"

「…」

"You survived by watching this story. You know that too. This story is not just the main character's story. This story—"

This is a story for one reader.

"We made it together."

The protagonist is not the protagonist from the beginning. It is only when there is a 'reader' who reads the protagonist and wants to become the protagonist that he becomes the protagonist.

Is it because [Advanced Multi-species Communication] worked? For the first time, I felt like the Second Kim Dokja was looking back at me. Then a voice came into my head.

「If this story continues, one of us has to become the 'Protagonist'.」

"…"

「Because this world is now a story for 'One Reader'.」

I couldn't bring myself to refute that statement.

The Second's words are what I thought. If this world continues, Kim Dokja will eventually have to kill Kim Dokja.

The fact that, just like other Kim Dokja fragments, the stories that seek to hide the 'One and Only Kim Dokja' will continue.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', stirs.]

The Second Kim Dokja said.

「I'm trying to stop that story.」

Is it because of [High-level Multi-species Communication] that I'm being persuaded by his story right now?

For a moment, that thought crossed my mind. Wouldn't it be better if everything turned into 'Fear' just like he thought? Is the 'ending' that we have to see while enduring all the tragedies that lie ahead really meaningful?

「Do you really think the story will stop when you close the book?」

That wasn't the voice of the 'King of Fear'.

I felt goosebumps running down my spine. There was someone else in the Snowfield.

I saw Baekcheong's strong energy cutting through the air with a clear sword sound.

「Everything is already written, and it is being written at the same time.」

A pure white coat fluttering. His sword traced a trajectory with a faint smile, just like the day we first met.

「So, as long as even one reader is curious about the next story.」

In an instant, the 'King of Fear's' arm flew through the air. The 'Blade of Faith' radiating light was burning pure white before my eyes.

Treading on the pitch-black snow that had fallen, 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' turned to me and said.

「The story is not over.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 865 Episode 47 King of Fear (9)

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There were three 'Kim Dokjas' that I've met so far.

First, the Demon King of Salvation.

The sponsor I made a contract with, and now my First Brother' who helps me inside the [Fourth Wall].

Second, the King of Fear.

The Master of the Fear Realm, and the being who created the Time Fault. My 'Second Brother' who tries to turn the entire <Star Stream> into a 'Fear Realm'.

Three, Snowfield Kim Dokja.

The Kim Dokja that I first met.

The Kim Dokja that spoke to me in the snowfield and gave me tea.

The only one who wasn't called by a 'modifier', he wasn't the First, the Second, or the Third Kim Dokja that hadn't yet appeared.

I knew who he was.

'49% Kim Dokja'.

A Kim Dokja who was torn apart in the process of the 'Oldest Dream' being shattered into fragments, just like me. The difference was that he fell into the Snowfield, not on Earth, and was raised by Cheon Inho there.

He probably increased the total amount of 'Kim Dokja fragments' through Cheon Inho. And eventually, he must have gained enough strength to threaten the status of the main body.

That's right. This 'Kim Dokja' in front of me right now is—

「It's been a long time.」

The one who tore Kim Dokja's main body apart and created the current 'Kim Dokja brothers'.

"You—"

I opened my mouth with a trembling voice.

Is it because of my mood? It felt different from when I met him before. His smile, which had felt strangely sad and hazy, had darkened a little.

「You've finally come this far, ■■.」

Pitch-black stories fell from the 'Unbreakable Faith' he held. It was the story of the 'King of Fear'.

Ignoring the screams of the stories, he spoke with his lips pursed.

「You lost your name, you.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja smiled bitterly as if he knew what had happened.

「I told you. Tell me the story you want to tell.」

"…"

「If you had done as I said, you wouldn’t have lost your name.」

The story I wanted.

I couldn’t help but feel repulsed by those words.

What on earth was the story I wanted to tell? What story should I have told so that I wouldn’t lose my name?

「Well, it doesn’t matter. You wanted to become 'Kim Dokja' too.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja turned his back on me as he said that. The King of Fear was looking at me from afar. Before I knew it, his severed arm was regenerating.

I staggered and stood up.

I don’t know why 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' had appeared here. However, I instinctively felt a sense of rejection. I felt that I couldn’t just leave him alone.

"Why did you come here?"

A different fighting spirit began to flow from the King of Fear’s body. It was a huge aura that seemed to cover the entire Snowfield with 'Fear'.

Snowfield Kim Dokja also began to manifest his power. It was a magnificent story that I had never witnessed before.

「■■-ah.」

My name was filtered and inaudible. Even so, I could clearly feel that he was calling me.

「I came to save you.」

Considering the situation, his words were right. However, the moment I saw the smile on his face, I had an ominous feeling.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', shakes.]

The [Fourth Wall] twitched as if in agreement with that feeling. The fierce anger of the 'First Kim Dokja' could be felt from beyond the wall.

Snowfield Kim Dokja continued to ask, whether he knew my condition or not.

「If we don't stop that guy, this world line will be destroyed. Do you want that?」

I shook my head. Of course I wouldn't want that. I also want to protect this world line.

「Then back off. I'll take care of this.」

I didn't back down. I felt like I shouldn't do that. I knew why I was thinking that way.

"You're thinking of absorbing the 'King of Fear', right?"

Snowfield Kim Dokja looked at me blankly, then asked back without changing his expression at all.

「Is there a reason why I can't?」

The moment I saw that expression that resembled me more than any other Kim Dokja, my heart skipped a beat.

「You absorbed the 'Demon King of Salvation' too, right?」

"I didn't absorb him."

「Aha. So he's inside the [Fourth Wall] of his own free will?」

Snowfield Kim Dokja smiled brightly and reached out to me. The moment his long fingers touched my cheek, sparks flew out with a tsutsutsu sound.

[Exclusive skill 'Fourth Wall' is strongly activated!]

Snowfield Kim Dokja looked at me with his characteristically hazy smile and asked.

「How long will that trick work?」

"..."

「Eventually, 'Kim Dokja' will gather again. Because the <Star Stream> wants it.」

His voice sounded unfamiliar.

Was Snowfield Kim Dokja originally like this? Who on earth changed him into this? Or was he originally like this, and I was seeing things wrong?

"If it was going to be like this anyway, why did you tell me to tell 'my story'?"

At one time, I trusted him. I thought he would be on my side, that he would support me no matter what. No matter what anyone said, he was the first person who told me to tell 'my story'.

「You couldn't do it in the end.」

The moment I heard that, I thought I knew what had changed him.

「You couldn't make your story right. You couldn't do this or that right, and you became 'an ordinary Kim Dokja'.」

An ordinary Kim Dokja.

「That's why I'm going to do it.」

Maybe it was me who changed him.

It was the story I made.

「I am you.」

For the first time, his smile didn't feel beautiful.

「You're just standing there watching like you always have. Until this 'Round' ends.」

I turned around without saying anything and looked at his back. A gorgeous white coat fluttering in the wind. A back that looked better in a coat than any other Kim Dokja I'd ever seen.

In the end, the story is about the main character.

And in this war of Kim Dokjas, maybe I am not the main character.

Snowfield Kim Dokja opened his mouth to the King of Fear.

「We don't need to talk long.」

[The story, 'Wanderer of the Snowfield', begins its storytelling.]

Wanderer of the Snowfield.

It was a story that had never appeared in the main story.

[The story, 'Master of Fear', howls!]

In response, the 'King of Fear' also brought out his story. The two tales howled at each other for a long time, and in the next moment, 'Snowfield Kim Dokja's' footsteps

disappeared.

Then, a loud noise shook the entire Snowfield.

Snowfield Kim Dokja, wrapped in Baekcheong's strong energy, was pushing the King of Fear. A quick and clear swordsmanship reminiscent of Lee Jihye's [Instant Kill]. [Full Electrification] that can be freely activated even without [Miniaturization]. The splendid strong energy that extended from the swordsmanship exploded like firecrackers, destroying the King of Fear's entire body.

But the King of Fear didn't just take it easy. The King of Fear, who had been crouching, spread his wings wide. The dust that fell from his wings seemed to cover the entire Snowfield, and then a huge vortex formed around several dust particles.

The vortex soon turned into a pitch-black portal.

【Ooooooooooo!】

A pitch-black tentacle appeared beyond the portal.

I immediately realized what kind of deity it was.

「This is interesting.」

The 'Outer Gods of Natural Disasters' including the 'Dream Eater' crossed the portal to save the 'King of Fear'.

「This is really an ability that is not like 'Kim Dokja'.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja activated [Baekcheong-ganggi] again. It was a skill on a different level than the [Baekcheong-ganggi] I had used.

The 'Blade of Faith' that was dozens of times longer cut off the 'Dream Eater's' leg.

【Ooooooooooo!】

As the 'Dream Eater' roared, other Outer Gods began to surge in through the portal. Outer Gods ranging from Disaster-level to Catastrophe-level fear. They were Gods of the Other World who lived in Fear under the 'King of Fear'.

Snowfield Kim Dokja cut down the Outer Gods rushing in without hesitation. The corpses of the Outer Gods who were cut down in an instant were piling up on the Snowfield’s floor.

They were talking.

「I don’t like it.」

Death was rising.

「I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it I don't like it.」

I approached the two of them through the corpses of Outer Deities. However, due to the stories of Outer Gods pouring out of the air, the two of them were no longer visible.

The sense of distance seemed to prove the gap between them and me.

As if there was no room for me to interrupt, the two stood in their respective positions. One was to destroy the world line, and the other side was to prevent the destruction of the world line.

Then where is my position?

Am I on the side that wants to destroy the world line, or the side that wants to protect the world line?

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', growls.]

If not both, then where is my position that does not choose both?

「"Tell me your story."」

In return for choosing this position, what was the story I ultimately wanted to write?

Once again, I felt someone grab my hand tightly. It was Giyeon hyung. Giyeon hyung's body, holding me tightly with his small hands, was shining brightly.

Giyeon hyung's memories flowed into me through the [Fourth Wall].

「"Writing interesting stories is protecting world peace."」

That's right.

「"If everyone is focused on my story, people won't fight with each other."」

I nodded without realizing it and took a step, I took another step.

My steps were not as flashy as those of other Dokjas. But I also walked diligently.

"If you have a mouth, you can talk, and if you have ears, you can listen."

There is an interesting story left in my head. That story is not over yet.

"So listen to me."

There is an ending that I absolutely must write. There is a debt that I must repay, and there are sentences that I must write.

And to fill in those sentences.

"Don't fight, you rascals!"

This 'space between the lines' must still be empty.

[The story 'Way of the Wind' begins its storytelling!]

They are not the only ones who are not restricted by probability here.

I am the same.

I may not be as strong or have overwhelming skill as them, but I am also a Dokja. I can fight in my own way.

"I told you to stop!"

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

Even with [Incite] with a greatly increased proficiency, I couldn't stop them.

I thought. I needed a sentence that would stop them even for a moment. But what should I say now to stop them?

What would be the most effective way to provoke them right now?

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is strongly activated!]

I jumped over the corpses of the Outer Gods and flew into the air, opening my mouth at them.

"You guys—"

Even if these words were not true, if I could just steal a moment from you.

"Aren’t Kim Dokja!"

With a 'tsutsutsu' sound, sparks flew out of the air.

The two Kim Dokjas, who had not responded at all until now, looked back at me at the same time. A deep silence fell over the battlefield for a moment. Neither of them opened their mouths, but both of them were asking me with their gazes.

「What did you just say?」

I laughed, hiding the cold sweat running down my back.

"Aren't you curious?"

Seriously, you damn brothers.

"Why did my words, which weren't even true, stop you for a moment?"

Maybe I envy you.

I envy those of you who don’t doubt the fact that you are 'Kim Dokja'. I feel ashamed of myself for constantly running to become Kim Dokja and become even a little bit like him.

However, because I have been running like that, because I am Kim Dokja, who is weaker than anyone else, there are things I can do.

I stood between the two who were glaring at me and stretched out my hand and said.

"In fact, you know that too. If it were the real Kim Dokja, he wouldn’t act like that."

As soon as I finished saying that, a storm of stories swept through the two beings’ bodies. It seemed as if they didn’t care whether I was in the middle or not, whether my soul was torn apart or not.

"You will come out like that."

They knew that too. That my current power wouldn’t be enough to stop them anyway.

But there were also things that the two of them didn’t know. For example,

"You who seek old Fears."

The fact that from now on, I am not the one who will stand between them.

"I will fulfill the record of our promise here and now."

It was a card I didn’t want to use if possible. But there was no other way. Because on one side, [Baekcheong-ganggi] as big as a house was coming, and on the other side, the magic waves of the Outer Gods were coming.

With the order to fulfill the contract, a pillar of light rose from the center of the Snowfield.

【Ahahahaha! You finally kept your promise with me!】

Asmodeus appeared in a pitch-black gothic dress, along with a gorgeous blue.

[The Recorder of Fear 'Demon King of the Cinema' agrees to a contract with you.]

And the next moment, Asmodeus, who had grasped the situation, glared at me and screamed.

【Oh, damn Kim Dokja!】

A huge explosion occurred.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 866 Episode 47 King of Fear (10)

【Kuaaaaat—!】

Along with Asmodeus's scream, a deafening roar echoed.

I crouched down, grabbing the wrist of the guy who was trying to run away.

【Let go of this! Damn it!】

Asmodeus tried to shake me off and run away, but he realized it was too late and began to unfold his own story. The story he built up while living as the 'Recorder of Fear' and 'Outer God'.

[The story, 'False Demon's Banquet', begins its storytelling.]

Surprisingly, it was a story I had read in 'Ways of Survival'.

「False Demon's Banquet.」

The characteristics of this story, where the number of uses resets every time the full moon rises, were as follows.

「Change all attacks that pour down on you for 1 minute into banquet fireworks.」

Originally, it was a technique used by the Highest-Ranking Demon King 'Ruler of Eastern Hell' Agares in some rounds, but for some reason, it seemed that Asmodeus had inherited the story.

The fierce blue that surged from the air was transformed into a splendid banquet fireworks. A vivid baptism of fireworks that dyed the white night of the Snowfield red and blue.

【Kim Dokja.】

Asmodeus was glaring at me from the center of the fireworks.

【Why did you call me in this situation?】

I laughed, still not letting go of the guy's wrist.

"You were the one who asked me to call you when I meet the King of Fear."

When I met Asmodeus in the Recorder's Room a while ago, I had made a promise with Asmodeus in exchange for getting my brother back.

'If I meet the King of Fear, I will call him.'

I simply kept that promise.

【It’s not just the King of Fear here!】

Asmodeus looked around with bloodshot eyes.

On one side was Snowfield Kim Dokja, who was spreading a cold air, and on the other side was the King of Fear, who was emitting an unreadable aura.

[The story, 'False Demon’s Banquet', stammers its storytelling.]

Sparks flew in the air, and the story’s power began to weaken.

It was natural. Those two Kim Dokjas were among the strongest Transcendent beings I’ve ever encountered. At least in this 'Snowfield', even the Myth-grade Constellations wouldn’t be able to stop them.

I couldn’t even guess how much probability it would take to replace the attacks they were pouring out with firecrackers.

"Please stop the fight. Can’t you?"

【Why should I do that?】

"If you don’t stop that, your plan will go awry."

I don’t know, but Asmodeus must have been thinking of confronting the King of Fear directly and taking his power.

However, even for Asmodeus, it was impossible to deal with both of them at once.

Asmodeus must have noticed my intentions and let out a bitter smile.

【You’ve made quite a gamble, Kim Dokja.】

Asmodeus looked back and forth between the King of Fear and Snowfield Kim Dokja and said.

【It’s true that if the two 'big fragments' here merge, my position will be a bit awkward.】

"Will you stop them?"

【Even I can’t deal with them for long in this space.】

The range of the firecrackers was shrinking in real time. Even for Asmodeus, it seemed too much to delay this situation.

"Can’t you borrow the power of the kkoma Kim Dokjas in the theater?"

【Do you think it’s that easy to make the kkoma Kim Dokjas imagine the same thing?】

Judging by the probability flowing through his body, it seems that the kkoma Kim Dokjas’ power was already being used right away.

【If you hand over your [Fourth wall] to me, that would be another matter.】

We smiled at each other. Both of us already knew that it was an impossible deal.

In the end, Asmodeus took a step back first.

【I can make it in a little while.】

"How much in a little while?"

【Five minutes, more than that is impossible. So—】

With the sound of probability, the power of the story shattered. The firecrackers disappeared and the stories from both sides surged toward us.

Asmodeus kicked my chest with his foot and said.

【With that smart head, find a way quickly!】

I fell to the ground and was buried in the Snowfield.

Almost at the same time, a pitch-black shadow appeared in the air.

【Okay, everyone. It's intermission time.】

The entire sky turned pitch black like a movie theater screen with the lights off, and soon a huge hexagonal black substance appeared.

[The story 'Silver Screen Seal' begins its storytelling.]

Asmodeus, Snowfield Kim Dokja, and the King of Fear were nowhere to be seen. It seemed like all three were inside that hexagonal object.

It was a story that reminded me of 'The Seal of the Apocalypse'.

Is that technique a desperate move that can buy me 5 minutes?

While the Outer Gods crawling on the floor howled like cats that had lost their owners, I desperately racked my brain to find a way to make the most of the time Asmodeus had given me.

This is the 'Snowfield'.

All the resources I have can be put to the best use here.

But in a situation where [Incite] doesn't work, what on earth can I do to stop them? I thought about borrowing the power of First Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation', but there was no response, perhaps because there was a problem with the communication of the [Fourth Wall] since a while ago.

Then, it must mean that it is time to reveal the cards I have been saving up one by one.

I let out a light sigh and started to receive the 'Fear Rewards' that I had been putting off.

[Would you like to use the item 'Story Fragment Selection Ticket'?]

"Use it."

Story Fragment Selection Ticket.

This was the reward I received when I successfully interpreted the fear of 'Subway Home' when I entered the Transcendent Alliance.

Unfortunately, it was a flaw that it was called 'Story Fragment' instead of 'Story', but I was grateful for this now.

[Prints a list of available story fragments.]

1. The Relationship Between Hands and Feet

2. The Friend of a Small Stone

3. The Bone That the Demon King Threw Away After Eating

4. A Piece of Starlight in the Water

5. A Dumpling That Someone Left Behind

…

However, I could not find any useful story fragments. It was the same no matter how many pages I turned. Most of the story fragments I could see were trashy story fragments.

Still, I did not give up hope.

How many compensation pages did I turn? Finally, a story fragment that seemed useful appeared.

"I will choose story fragment number 214."

[Acquired story fragment 'Graffiti on the Wall'.]

Graffiti on the wall. It was a story that seemed like nothing special just by hearing the name.

But according to my thoughts, this story was related to 'that person'.

[Story fragment 'Graffiti on the wall' begins its storytelling.]

As if a warm match was lit on the Snowfield, the story began.

「"I'll be really sad if I tell everything and no one understands. Everyone has a wall and communication is impossible... It's obvious."」

"Still, we have to talk about anything. After all, there is someone on the other side of that wall."」

Outer Gods who were wandering around gathered nearby one by one to watch the story.

「"There's a wall, so what can you talk about?"」

"You can just write on the wall."」

I also stood in the gap between them and watched the old story. Even though it wasn't the story I lived, I somehow felt nostalgic. Maybe it's because I, too, used a part of my life to write this story.

In the end, like the conversation with Kim Dokja that day, this story remained as a story, and it is being read by someone now.

"I know you're there."

As I said this, I felt a small presence behind me. Then, a being appeared, tearing the space apart like a curtain. He was a warrior who protected the 'King of Fear'.

A fiercely rippling shadow.

I met the sadly shining eyes above the shadow's face.

"The King of Transcendents."

That was his nickname.

He was the most perfect incarnation in this world. A person born into the world through Kim Dokja's comment.

"Jang Hayoung."

The shadow's appearance changed with my words. As if she were only revealing her veil to those who could recognize her, her hair changed to a swaying golden color.

However, it was not a situation to be amazed. Because she immediately spoke in a sharp voice.

[How do you have that story?]

"Because I'm also Kim Dokja."

I don't think it was a coincidence that this story fragment came to me. As Snowfield Kim Dokja said, all Kim Dokja fragments have the property of attracting each other. So perhaps this story fragment came to me too.

"Would you like to see more?"

[…Yes.]

We listened to the story of the story fragment in silence.

The story contained in the fragment was short.

「"The other person won't know what's happening on the other side of the wall anyway?"」

At most, it was a few words of conversation between Kim Dokja and Jang Hayoung.

「"At least that wall has changed. Then, maybe someone will read it someday."」

The scenery of the restaurant and the air of that day, which lingered like the sound of a broken music box. Like a lit match going out, the memories quickly dispersed into smoke.

Jang Hayoung urged.

[One more time.]

I activated the story fragment once more. The story spoke and we listened. After a while, the story went out again.

[One more time.]

"No."

[Why?]

"We don’t have much time. Instead, if you grant me a favor, I will show you the story again as many times as you want."

Jang Hayoung looked at the story fragment with regretful eyes and asked.

[What is your request?]

"Don't you already know?"

Jang Hayoung hesitated for a moment and shook her head.

[No.]

I knew you would say that.

Even so, I asked in a shameless voice.

"We must stop that fight. Isn't it your duty to protect the King of Fear?"

Jang Hayoung, the King of Transcendents.

If she had seen the end of the scenarios with <Kim Dokja’s Company> in the 1,864th round, she would definitely be able to mediate that fight.

But.

[Even if that were my duty, I can't grant your request.]

"Why?"

[I can't interfere with the 'Kim Dokjas’' affairs.]

It seemed that she had some special restrictions.

Well. Unlike other members <Kim Dokja’s Company>, the reason she was able to descend directly into the 'Fear Realm' was because she had placed such restrictions on herself.

"That fight could kill the King of Fear."

[I know. But that's not 'real death' in the strict sense.]

Jang Hayoung seemed to have a vague idea about our situation.

A war to choose a single Kim Dokja. When Kim Dokja and Kim Dokja fight, the true side is absorbed into the other Kim Dokja. If we don’t recognize each fragment as a single entity, then this fight will only be seen as a journey to become a complete Kim Dokja.

I swallowed a light sigh and opened my mouth.

"Okay. Then can I ask you something else?"

[What is it?]

"The [Unidentified Wall] you have. Can you still use it?"

Jang Hayoung tilted her head for a moment and said.

[Well… I can still use some of its functions. But why?]

If I remember correctly, the [Unidentified Wall] had several functions.

For example.

"Then it would be possible to contact the Constellations."

Through the [Unidentified Wall], Jang Hayoung was able to communicate one-on-one with 'almost all beings' in the <Star Stream>. In fact, in the main story, Jang Hayoung used this ability to trade with various Constellations. I asked, looking at the rewards of the Fear Realm that I had not yet received.

"Can I contact people from other worldlines through that 'wall'?"

[That's not possible.]

As expected, even if it's the [Unidentified Wall], that would be difficult. I thought that if I could contact <Kim Dokja’s Company>, or if I could contact a Transcendent being like the 'Secretive Plotter', that would be great.

"Then this is only possible for this worldline."

I thought of the Constellations that could stop that confrontation in our worldline.

But no one came to mind easily.

If I really dealt with Zeus or Odin, then it would be different, but if I dealt with those guys, I would definitely lose all my stories and live as a slave to the giant nebula for hundreds of years.

I thought of other Constellations.

Like Uriel, Breaking the Sky Sword sAINT, or the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon... Sure, they were all attractive choices, but strangely enough, I wasn't sure if they could stop the fight.

While narrowing down my choices one by one, someone's name suddenly came to mind.

Wait, could that person work too?

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 867 Episode 47 King of Fear (11)

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The Demon King of Salvation— The First Kim Dokja shouted as he hurriedly repaired the broken library.

「(Kids! Stop it! Quickly!)」

At the order of the Demon King of Salvation, the kkoma Kim Dokjas moved around. When some of them blocked the broken library frame with newspapers, the trembling stories became quiet.

After the series of events that the Youngest experienced in the Fear Realm, the [Fourth Wall] became very unstable.

It was probably because this [Fourth Wall] itself was not complete.

The First Kim Dokja frowned and turned the newspaper on the table.

「(Damn it, this is how it is—)」

In fact, the events in the library were nothing compared to the events that the Youngest was experiencing.

The [Fourth Wall] shook once again, and a new sentence was created in the newspaper.

「Kugugugugugu!」

The confrontation between Kim Dokja and Kim Dokja continued on the blank sheet of paper.

The Second Kim Dokja—the First Kim Dokja bit his lips after confirming 'that guy' who was confronting the King of Fear.

He never thought that guy would show up!

He knew that the guy would often come to see the Youngest in the form of dreams, but he never expected that he would intervene so blatantly.

It must be possible because it was the 'Snowfield'.

The Snowfield is a place that is least affected by the probability of the <Star Stream>.

Even in such a place, the entire Snowfield was filled with sparks due to the stories the two Kim Dokjas were spewing out.

It was then that the Youngest's thoughts floated over the newspaper.

「Wait, could that person work too?」

As expected, the Youngest seemed to be thinking of stopping this fight. At his judgment, which was typical of the Youngest, the first nodded and thought.

If it were me, who would I call? The [Unidentified Wall] has a limitation that it cannot send messages to other worldlines, so the choices were limited.

'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint or Uriel.'

The problem was whether he could summon them to the Snowfield. No matter how strong the Constellation was, there were only a limited number of beings that the Youngest could summon to the 'Snowfield'.

The Eldest Kim Dokja, immediately turned on his smartphone and made a call.

「(Damn, is the Third child on airplane mode again?)」

As expected, the Third Kim Dokja, did not answer the call.

But it didn't seem like he could ask for help from Yoo Joonghyuk or <Kim Dokja’s Company> of other worldlines.

In the case of <Kim Dokja’s Company>, there was no way to enter this Snowfield...

No way.

Would only beings who could come to the Snowfield really be able to stop this situation?

An ominous feeling rose in his head.

「(Wait a minute. Youngest, no way.)」

No way. Even if the Youngest is crazy, he wouldn’t dare to take such a risk. If he makes a mistake, the entire Fear Realm could be blown away—

「(No way? Hey! You bastard!)」

Then, the blank page on which the Youngest’s story was written slowly began to tear apart.

---

I told Jang Hayoung the name I had thought of and asked if she could send a message. Then Jang Hayoung answered.

[Um, that person is not officially affiliated with the <Star Stream>?]

"Then it won’t work?"

[The message can be delivered. This is the first time this has happened. It’s amazing.]

Then there’s hope.

The problem is whether I can persuade 'that being'.

[What should I send? By the way, I can only send one word.]

"Can you send an item as well?"

As far as I know, the [Unidentified Wall] has a function that allows you to exchange skills or items.

[What is it?]

"This is it."

Jang Hayoung looked down at the item I handed her and nodded.

[I can send this. What about the message?]

After I took a deep breath and sent the message, Jang Hayoung tilted her head and asked back.

[You really sent it like that?]

"Yes."

[This is the first time I've received such a strange message since 'Grow Up, Hairy Head'... Okay, I sent it.]

The message was sent. The message that flew through the wall must have crossed this 'Snowfield' and reached the man floating in space.

How would he react when he opened the message? Honestly, I didn't really expect it. He was such an unpredictable man.

10 seconds, 20 seconds, 30 seconds... 1 minute.

Time passed, and there was no reply.

Jang Hayoung asked after seeing my expression.

[Are you anxious?]

"I'm anxious."

Jang Hayoung looked at me blankly and said.

[Kim Dokja was always anxious.]

"Was he? It's a little different from the Kim Dokja I know."

I thought about the Kim Dokja in the main story. The Kim Dokja I remember was always a calm man.

Jang Hayoung laughed.

[People who try too hard to hide it actually make it obvious.]

Kim Dokja as a human being who wasn't recorded in the main story. Maybe Jang Hayoung read Kim Dokja's wall.

[When I see you, I think about that time a lot.]

"Well, I'm Kim Dokja too."

[You try to think like that, right?]

"Does the [Unidentifiable Wall] also have the ability to blurt out other people's thoughts?"

[That's a great Kim Dokja speech.]

"I tried."

[I thought that was really unique. You're already Kim Dokja, but you're trying to become Kim Dokja.]

I laughed weakly. Suddenly, a question I wanted to ask came to mind.

"What kind of Kim Dokja was the King of Fear?"

[A guy who understands sadness.]

Jang Hayoung continued speaking while looking up at the seal of Asmodeus floating in the air.

[Even without saying anything, I felt understood when I stood next to him. I liked that feeling so I stayed by his side for a long time.]

"Don't you feel sorry?"

[It's a shame. But there's nothing I can do. He said so. If something like this happens, don't interfere.]

She won't get involved in Kim Dokja's fight.

That must have been the promise between the 'King of Fear' and the 'Fighter'.

I realized it anew.

How serious are both the King of Fear and Snowfield Kim Dokja in this fight.

No matter who becomes the last Kim Dokja, they are simply trying to fill the gap in this story with 'Kim Dokja's War'.

On the other hand, what about me?

"I'm a coward."

[Why?]

"Because I'm trying to borrow the power of another being for Kim Dokja's fight."

I thought of Kim Dokja and the King of Fear, who were engaged in a fierce battle inside the seal.

To be honest, I had been overwhelmed ever since I witnessed their true power.

I thought I had become quite strong after going through the 40th Time Fault. At least in this Snowfield, I believed that I could compete with anyone.

But when I actually witnessed the two, that confidence disappeared as if it had been washed away.

The feeling of seeing a being who was much more complete as 'Kim Dokja' than me.

If we simply considered the number of 'Kim Dokja fragments' that I had, there wouldn't have been much of a difference between me and the 'King of Fear', but our levels of completion were noticeably different.

The kind of 'gap in class' that only a being who understood the stories they had better than anyone else could express.

[Is that a bad thing?]

I suddenly woke up from my thoughts at Jang Hayoung's question.

[Asking for help has always been Kim Dokja’s specialty.]

"Thank you for the consolation."

[Not consolation. I’m just telling the truth, and do you think it’s easy to become a coward?]

Jang Hayoung continued speaking without any noticeable change in expression.

[Only those who know what's important to them can become cowards. Kim Dokja knew that well. He could become a conman of this <Star Stream> for his colleagues many times.]

"…"

[Just like you are now.]

I smiled bitterly.

"That's when my con is successful."

There was still no reply from the [Unidentified Wall].

From afar, with a squeak, I could see Asmodeus's [Silver Screen Seal] breaking.

【Keu…】

But I still had one more card left.

[You have successfully interpreted the ■■-level Fear, 'Evil Sophist'.]

[Would you like to receive the delayed reward?]

I had not yet received the reward for clearing the Time Fault 'Evil Sophist'.

I don't know what I will get with this reward, but if I use it, my chances of winning will go up a little.

I held on to my 'Unbreakable Faith' and took a deep breath. Even if I die here, even if I can't stop them, I will do what I can. Like Kim Dokja.

[Wait.]

At that moment, Jang Hayoung stopped me.

[Something is here.]

I felt it too. Something strange was approaching from across the sky.

A huge force that tore apart the entire vast space and flew in. At that moment, Snowfield Kim Dokja, the King of Fear, and Asmodeus all had no choice but to look up at the sky with the same expression.

As something suddenly occurred to him, Asmodeus looked down at me and shouted.

【What on earth did you call—!】

Looking at Asmodeus, whose face was pale, I recalled the name of the man I had called.

Judging by the fact that something like that was flying towards me, it seemed that my message had arrived properly.

By the way, the message I sent him was as follows.

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—I will take you back to the past you wanted to go back to.

When Jaehwan first received that message, he thought that there was a crazy guy in this universe.

It was clear who the crazy guy was.

"Judging by the way he speaks, it's that guy."

It must have been that Heo Yeo-geon—the guy who called him 'Jaehwan-nim'—who sent him nonsense.

"He must want to die, judging by the nonsense he sent."

The Monarch Slayer Jaehwan.

Anyone who knows him even a little bit knows that the word he hates the most is 'regression'.

Because of that damn 'regression', he lost his comrades, lost his friends, and had to continue his journey alone up the terrifying 《Tower of Nightmare》.

How dare he offer to 'regression' to him?

Regardless of whether the offer was possible or not, it was something that only a human who had escaped the temporary ship could dare to do.

Jaehwan began to put strength into the sword he had taken out of his waist.

"It seems he’s hiding in a strange place."

His power as an Awakened person was manifested.

「Suspicious and Understanding.」

The path the message had come from was clearly visible on his retina.

"Did you think I wouldn't be able to find you if you hid?"

Jaehwan's sword strike began to condense the tremendous stabbing energy.

Sparks exploded like firecrackers all over his body.

[The Management Bureau has detected your dangerous actions!]

At the same time, a pure white spark net spread around him. As if someone was trying to restrain his actions, putting a limit on probability on him.

A dazzling pillar of light began to descend from the sky.

[The Great Dokkaebi, 'Halong', descends to the area!]

[The Great Dokkaebi, 'Holong', descends to the area!]

[The Great Dokkaebi, 'Noksoo', descends to the area!]

[The Great Dokkaebi, 'Onsae', descends to the area!]

[The Great Dokkaebi, 'Haesol', descends to the area!]

As many as five Great Dokkaebis appeared in the scenario to stop him.

Great Dokkaebis.

Except for the 'Dokkaebi King', the king of stories, these are the Executive-level dokkaebis who can wield the most powerful power in the Management Bureau. The fact that five of them appeared at the same time was an unusual event even in the long history of the <Star Stream>.

Jaehwan quickly realized who they were.

"Are you the 'Cultivators' of this worldline?"

Then the Great Dokkaebis answered.

['Monarch Slayer', you must not interfere with the affairs of the <Star Stream>.]

When the Great Dokkaebi 'Oksu' spoke, the Great Dokkaebi 'Onsae' next to him nodded.

[No one can go against the law of probability.]

The last one to speak was the Great Dokkaebi 'Haesol'.

[This is not the world you lived in. No spiritual power and world power. It’s not the 《Tree OF imaginary》 that is dominated by settings and components.]

"..."

[Do you really not know what the beings who interfered with the events of another dimension are saying?]

"I don't know what they are talking about, but..."

Jaehwan glared at the dokkaebis surrounding him.

The power of awakening was manifested once again in his eyes.

「Suspicion and Understanding.」

With that power, he read the story of the 'Management Bureau' behind the dokkaebis, and noticed the existence of the 'Dokkaebi King' who controlled it.

And he read the universe of this distant <Star Stream> where the Dokkaebi King served.

And what was at the end of that universe was...

With a tsususu sound, his power went out. There was something at the end of this world that even he, as of now, could not fully read.

Jaehwan snickered.

"That's interesting."

Suddenly, he wondered how that Heo Yeogeon guy would navigate this universe. He became curious.

Jaehwan concentrated his strength on his right hand holding the sword once more.

The dokkaebi Noksu warned.

[Wait, if you don’t stop right now—!]

Jaehwan thought.

Perhaps this was all part of that sly guy’s scheme. Although he didn’t like the feeling of falling for that trap, Jaehwan decided to let him fool him this time.

It was because of the object that had come flying in with the message.

Jaehwan quietly looked down at the dumpling he was holding in his left hand, then took a big bite. The moment he took the dumpling, he felt a surge of longing.

'Surely, what that guy said, 'I’ll make you go back'…'

Suddenly, names came to mind. Chunghuh. Karlton. Ryunard. The names of people who had liked him but were no longer around. Jaehwan shook his head as if shaking off his thoughts.

'That can’t be true.'

And he swung his sword forward with all his might.

In Jaehwan’s swordsmanship, a wave of destruction that tore through space rushed.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 868 Episode 47 King of Fear (12)

The sky was splitting apart like a canvas. Beyond the shattered Snowfield sky, a pitch-black energy could be seen flying. No, I don’t know if that can be called 'energy'. What was certain was that it was tearing apart the sky of this world.

[Wow.]

That was Jaehwan’s stab.

Jang Hayoung muttered in admiration.

[This is the first time I’ve seen something like that in my life.]

This is the 'Snowfield'.

Even if it was Jaehwan, the slayer of monarchs, it wouldn’t be easy to enter here to deal with Kim Dokja.

But what if he could attack the 'Snowfield' itself from outside of the 'Snowfield'?

「Tearing the Constellations.」

If Jaehwan’s secret technique could shatter space and time, he thought it might be possible to temporarily dismantle the lines of this 'Snowfield'.

Fortunately, the gamble seemed to have paid off.

【How—】

The moment the astonished Asmodeus turned around, he saw the two Kim Dokjas floating in the air disappear. They also sensed the danger.

The problem was this.

Kwakwakwakwakwa!

That thing is flying out of the air, and I don't know how to get out of here.

The [□□] skill that determines entry into the Snowfield was not listening, and contact with the First Kim Dokja through the [Fourth Wall] was also cut off.

There was only one person I could trust right now.

"Please save me."

Jang Hayoung said, her eyes widening at my request.

[The Kim Dokja I know isn't as shameless as you.]

Jang Hayoung smiled and hugged me.

The next moment, my vision went blank and I was thrown out of the Snowfield.

Now that I think about it, I wasn't sure if I could return to my body like this.

My body is currently illegally occupied by Cheon Inho. No. Originally, that body belonged to Cheon Inho, so was it me who was occupying it illegally?

"Hmph."

I opened my eyes wide, wiping the saliva flowing from my mouth.

What is it? How did I come back?

Before I could even properly ask the question, a terrible pain shot through my stomach and other parts of my body.

I swallowed the pain and quickly looked around.

This was the 'Big House'.

If that's true, the scars left all over my body must have been from the fight with Yoo Joonghyuk.

I grabbed my stomach, which was leaking blood, and frowned.

[The exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is activated.]

At least the [Fourth Wall] was reactivated, relieving the pain.

Yoo Joonghyuk, how much did you beat him up?

I crouched and held my hands on the floor, catching my breath. My knees were shaking, so I couldn't even get up. How on earth did Cheon Inho fight with this body?

"Cheon Inho?"

When I raised my head, Anna Croft, covered in dust, was standing there.

I smiled and waved my hand toward her, who was already raising her spirits with wary eyes.

"Kim Anna-ssi."

Anna Croft, who was startled, blinked her eyes in astonishment. Her eyes seemed to suspect that I was tricking her.

I smiled and continued to speak with narrowed eyes to help her make her judgment.

"Have you forgotten your own name?"

"...Are you back?"

"Yes."

[Character, 'Anna Croft', is activating 'Lie Detection Lv. 10'.]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that your statement is true.]

Even in the midst of all that, she even had the sense to utilize [Lie Detection]. As expected, it was the quick reflexes of a Prophet. Anna Croft, who confirmed that I was not the 'real Cheon Inho', ran over and grabbed my hands and supported me. Then she

stood there awkwardly, as if she didn't know what to do, and lowered her head. I doubled over because I found the situation funny.

"You were worried, right?"

I thought she would naturally object strongly, but Anna Croft unexpectedly answered in a heavy voice.

"Yes."

I could feel her sincerity in her tone.

Come to think of it, we had been through a lot together, going through the fears of the Fear Realm and the Transcendent Alliance.

[Your giant tale is stirring.]

To build such a bond with that 'Prophet'.

If Yoo Joonghyuk had heard it, he would have been shocked.

I quietly let go of her hand and looked around.

"Where is Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"The tyrant is…"

Following her gaze, I saw Yoo Joonghyuk lying on the floor. I hurriedly approached the guy and checked his pulse and breathing.

"Hey."

Even though I shook his shoulder, Yoo Joonghyuk didn't wake up.

Anna Croft added.

"He's been like that since a while ago. No matter how much I try to wake him up, he doesn't respond at all."

I had a rough idea.

The 'Snowfield' where the Kim Dokjas fought fiercely was Yoo Joonghyuk's inner world. However, since that world was torn apart for a moment by Jaehwan's blow, there was a possibility that the shock had affected Yoo Joonghyuk's reality.

"It'll be okay. I think he just fainted for a moment."

If he was really in a dangerous state, stories would have been running wild all over his body by now. However, his stories were surprisingly calm.

"What happened to Cheon Inho?"

Anna Croft asked back at my question as if it was absurd.

"Are you asking me that while you're in that body?"

"Yes."

Anna Croft shook her head at my shameless attitude.

"I don't know exactly. I saw the King defeat Cheon Inho, but..."

"What happened to his soul? Where did it disappear to?"

"The 'Eyes of the Great Demon' can't see that."

Even if it was Yoo Joonghyuk, he wouldn't have a way to destroy Cheon Inho's soul at that moment.

That means Cheon Inho voluntarily gave up his body to me.

It was hard for me to figure out his intentions.

Cheon Inho, who had a deeper love and hate for the main character than anyone else.

Why did that 'Evil Sophist' who struggled to be recorded on the 'Last Wall' give up his body again at a crucial moment?

...That's okay. It's not something that I can answer even if I think about it now.

"Kim Dokja."

Anna Croft, who had pulled up my sleeve, pointed her finger toward the cliff. The outside scenario area was reflected on the Fault screen of the cliff.

—Kuaaaah!

—Run! Run away!

The Outer Gods still held sway under the protection of the Fear Realm.

But upon closer inspection, the situation was a little different than before.

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', appears in the scenario area!]

The message from the Constellations striking the scenario area. Although it was not a full descent but a half-descent, the intervention of the Constellations in the scenario was still a spectacle.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', appears in the scenario area!]

[The Constellation, 'King of Gold', appears in the scenario area!]

Taking advantage of the gap in the probability scale due to the Fear Realm, the Constellations appeared in the scenario and fought against the Outer Gods.

[The Constellation, 'Master of the Guillotine', descends into the scenario area!]

[The Constellation, 'Snake Slicer', descends into the scenario area!]

[The Constellation, 'Soundless Sword', descends into the scenario area!]

Under the command of the Constellations, the Outer Gods of the Fear Realm began to push back little by little toward the portal.

The enthusiasm of the incarnations responding to them was also great.

—Oh!

—The Constellations have arrived!

—That's it! Just push a little harder!

That was expected. The Constellations that had been hiding until now are now appearing in the scenario area to help them, so the incarnations cannot help but be moved.

[The fame of the Constellations in the Korean Peninsula is rising!]

Anyway, even if the scale of probability was broken, it was surprising that the Constellations themselves stepped forward.

The Constellations probably had their own calculations. There may have been an agreement with the 'Giant Nebulae', or there may have been a behind-the-scenes deal

with the Administration.

In any case, they were working on the scenario with one mind and one heart for once.

【Ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah】

The 'Nameless Things' writhing in pain was running inside the portal again.

I shouted at the top of my lungs into the air.

"Second Brother! Let's stop now!"

No matter how many powerful Outer Gods remained in the Second Kim Dokja's Fear Realm, he couldn't fight against the entire <Star Stream>. In the end, he would lose and his Fear Realm would be sealed.

"If we keep fighting like this, we'll all die! You didn't become the 'King of Fear' to see this kind of thing!"

Did he hear my voice?

An ominous fog swirled around the center of the Big House, and soon the 'King of Fear' appeared. Perhaps because of the battle in the Snowfield, his expression looked very exhausted.

"O Watcher of Light and Darkness!"

I shouted his modifier. But he didn't look back at me. Instead, he was looking up at the sky.

When did it start?

The sky reflected in his compound eyes was splitting apart.

Only then did I realize what was happening.

Tsutsutsu.

The ceiling of the Big House was collapsing.

"Oh my God."

Anna Croft muttered as she backed away in fear. After checking the dark clouds hanging over the collapsed ceiling, I hurriedly looked for Jang Hayoung.

"Jang Hayoung!"

Jang Hayoung appeared as the empty space behind her rippled. As expected, her expression was clearly bewildered.

[Isn't that flying back again?]

"No."

At first, I thought Jaehwan had been angry at my message and was stabbing me again.

But something was different. Unlike Jaehwan's dry stab, the story that was now breaking through the ceiling was clearly filled with malice.

The next moment, a flash of light flew through the crack in the ceiling. The floor of the 'Big House' was on fire with enormous heat.

Smoke spread acridly.

I swallowed my cough and looked up at the sky.

The enormous power of a story condensed in the flash. It was a 'Giant Story' that felt familiar somewhere.

"No way."

As hundreds of flashes bombarded the 'Big House', Jang Hayoung finally stepped forward.

[Damn it, Kim Dokja! Step back!]

An enormous force flowed out from Jang Hayoung's entire body.

I realized once again why Jang Hayoung was called the 'King of the Transcendents'. The story surging from her entire body was proving who she was.

The [Invisible Sword] that Jang Hayoung created drew a translucent trajectory and pointed at the ceiling.

Breaking the Sky Sword.

Seasonal.

Pacheonseonggyeol.

The [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship]'s seasonal, Pacheonryuseonggyeol, collided with the flash like a rising meteor. The Pacheonryuseonggyeol's strong energy, which was offset by the flash, soon lost its strength and began to break apart.

Jang Hayoung did not stop.

Jeon Inhwa.

Baek Cheongmun's secret technique, [Jeon Inhwa], was activated, and Jang Hayoung's entire body was covered with Baek Cheong's aura. Baek Cheong's tension poured out from her fist with a fierce explosion.

At the moment when the momentum was faltering, Jang Hayoung moved the formless sword once again.

The third form.

The three swords of Cheok Jungyeong, created to cut the sea, exploded in Jang Hayoung's swordplay.

The harmony of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship], [Jeon Inhwa], and [Three Sword Style].

Jang Hayoung was drawing a landscape that three captains of the Transcendent Alliance could create on their own.

This was the true power of the 'King of Transcendents'.

Jang Hayoung's Three Swords, which finally pushed away the flash, detonated something beyond the ceiling.

I could feel the fierce waves of stories that shook the axis of the earth gradually diminishing.

[Damn, if only there were no probability constraints—]

It seems that Jang Hayoung cannot unleash 100% of her power in exchange for crossing the world line.

Nevertheless, when the dust cleared, Jang Hayoung was still firmly holding her position. Although her entire body was burnt black, she succeeded in defending the 'Big House' alone.

However, Jang Hayoung's expression was serious.

[You...]

Her eyes were filled with anger as she confirmed with her own eyes the being that appeared through the crack in the ceiling.

[How dare you. Do you know where this is?]

At the same time, the sound of something firing was heard from beyond the crack once again.

Jang Hayoung, whose complexion had changed, turned around and shouted.

[Kim Dokja, run away—]

With a dazzling flash of lightning, Jang Hayoung's body crashed into the floor of the 'Big House'.

It was unbelievable. There was an entity out there that could take down Jang Hayoung, the 'King of the Transcendents'?

Once again, the ceiling of the 'Big House' shook, and the sound of something squeezing into the ceiling was heard.

Kkuddeuk.

Dozens of ships appeared beyond the broken ceiling.

I knew those ships well, too. The 'Story Weapons' of the Giant Nebula that I witnessed in the final scenario of the 40th Round.

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is moving!]

[The Constellations of the small and medium Nebulaes are astonished by the appearance of the great being!]

[A probability aftermath is blowing!]

The ship of <Olympus>, the 'Argo', took the lead.

The moment I confirmed the Constellation leading them from the front, I thought I would accept Jang Hayoung's defeat.

Why on earth did that being appear here now?

At first, with an ominous feeling of foreboding, I felt as if the god aboard the 'Argo' recognized me.

But that couldn't be the case.

The fierce battle I had with him all happened in the Time Fault of the '40th Round'.

No, wait a minute.

「What if I'm not the only one who got the information of the '40th Round' through the 'Time Fault'?」

Damn it.

[The Constellation 'Seat of Lightning' reveals its status!]

<Olympus>'s strongest, Zeus, one of the three gods, aimed his holy relic, Astraphe, at the 'Great House'.

[Retrieve the fragment.]

The incantation fell.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 869 Episode 47 King of Fear (13)

All scenarios in the <Star Stream> have a 'scenario number'.

From 1 to 99. The scenario number represents the difficulty of the scenario and is designed to impose a level of probability appropriate to the difficulty.

This was a kind of safety net to prevent the 'Transcendent beings' of the upper scenarios from intruding into the lower scenarios.

「There is no scenario number in the Fear Realm.」

Even if there was no scenario number, since it came from 'Murim', a 20th scenario area anyway, I vaguely guessed that the 'Fear Realm' would have a difficulty level appropriate to it.

「But is the difficulty of the 'Fear Realm' really '20th scenario's' level?」

It was strange when I thought about it.

This is because the 'Fear Realm' has a special space called 'Time Fault'. Each Fault boasts a vastly different level of difficulty.

Even the 'Time Fault' that I cleared was based on the 'Last Scenario' of the 40th Round.

The last scenario.

No matter how much of an experience it is, there's no way that the '20th scenario' boasts such an absurd level of difficulty.

Kwakwakwakwakwa!

When Zeus and other <Olympus> warships rushed in beyond the broken 'Big House', I realized once again that there was something seriously wrong with the 'Fear' scenario.

Tsutsutsutsu.

A storm of probability was raging in the sky.

Normally, the Constellations in the sky would have been torn apart like scraps of paper the moment the storm struck.

However, it wasn't the Constellations that were being torn apart, but the Outer Gods.

【That ah ah ah ah ah ah ah】

The Outer Gods traveling near the cliff fault were trampled by the Constellations' boots. The flash cannons emitted from the battleship were destroying the cliffs of the 'Big House'.

I had never seen such a sight even in the last scenario of the 40th Round. That was because Cheon Inho and Yoo Joonghyuk had already destroyed most of the main forces of the Nebulae.

"Ah, ah..."

Anna Croft groaned and staggered, and I stood beside her, looking up at the sky in panic.

That was the true power of the 'Giant Nebula'.

【Oh oh oh oh oh oh oh】

The floor of the Big House rose and otherworldly deities appeared.

The headless dragon that roared through the sky, the giant babies that guarded the outskirts of the 'Big House'.

The 'Dream Eater' also let out a roar and stretched out its tentacles.

【Mak ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah】

And that wasn't all. There were also fears that had already been defeated by the Captains. For example, the 'Dragon Eater', the 'Darkness That Descends'. And—

【Kaka Kaka Kaka Kaka】

I also saw the appearance of the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' that I had defeated.

Like Jang Hayoung who first appeared as a Fighter, the Outer Gods covered in pitch-black shadows stood by the 'King of Fear'.

The Outer Gods who drew their weapons only to protect Kim Dokja.

【Protect the King of Fear】

If even one of these Outer Gods were dropped into the scenario area, the area would be devastated. Hope welled up as I realized that fact anew.

Maybe.

With the power of the 'King of Fear' and the fears he rules, they might be able to bring down the 'Giant Nebula' that was all-out.

【Ah ah ah ah ah ah ah】

And.

【Oh oh oh oh oh oh】

The war had begun.

"Join us! Quickly!"

I carried Yoo Joonghyuk and held Anna Croft's hand, and hid myself in the pouring gunfire.

[The story, 'Pebble and I', begins its storytelling.]

Relying on a weak story, we watched the scenery of the 'Big House' where everything was falling apart.

Until now, I thought that the Constellations were afraid of Outer Gods. That's why I believed that whenever Outer Gods appeared, the Constellations ran away or kept silent.

However, not all Constellations were like that.

[The great story of <Olympus> begins its storytelling!]

The Constellations that make up the main part of the story do not fear Outer Gods.

The arrow shot by the omnipotent sun Apollo brought down the headless dragon flying in the sky, and Achilles, Jason, and other great Constellations knocked down the giant babies.

[Hahahahahaha! How fun!]

Ares, the ferocious god of war who was riding the Gigantes, laughed as he cut off the leg of the 'Dream Eater'.

[Fire!]

Gwagwagwagwagwagwa!

【Oh oh oh oh oh oh】

The 'Dream Eater', who was hit by the battleship's flash cannon, twisted his body and let out a painful cry.

Following that, the Gigantes unit led by Ares began to cut down the main body of the 'Dream Eater'.

【Woo woo woo woo woo woo】

Even if it wasn't his own power, it was the first time I had seen an Outer God being so helpless.

Of course, not all the Outer Gods were helpless. There were Outer Gods who jumped into the midst of the great Constellations and slaughtered them mercilessly.

【Ka kaka kaka kaka kaka】

It was the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

Every time the famous swords held in his four hands made of bone drew a trajectory, the great Constellations of <Olympus> were sliced up like toys.

However, there was a Constellation that blocked his path. With a rough crack, the Constellation that breathed out hot breath like lava spoke.

[I wanted this guy's weapons.]

It was the volcanic blacksmith, 'Hephaestus', who swung a huge hammer.

[Kuaaaaap!]

As Hephaestus slammed his huge right foot into the ground, violent waves of stories erupted in an instant, causing large and small injuries to occur throughout the entire body of the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

However, the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' did not stay still either.

[Death]

Just two syllables. The great Constellations within a radius of several dozen meters fell down at the sound of the lion's roar contained in those syllables. The incarnations of the fallen great Constellations were all bleeding from their ears.

Hephaestus, who received the lion's roar from the front, also ground his teeth with bloodshot eyes.

[Athena! Artemis! Join us!]

Did he think it would be difficult alone? At his request for reinforcements, two more of the Twelve Gods joined in.

Athena's "Aegis" protected Hephaestus from the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne', and Artemis' arrows, which took advantage of the gap, struck the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne's' thighs and forearms.

【Ka Ka Ka Ka Ka Ka】

The 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' fought bravely against the three Twelve Gods. Even with his arms broken and his legs broken, he maintained his royal dignity until the end.

[Kwaaak! That damned Outer God—!]

Even in the midst of all this, the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne', who succeeded in blowing off one of Hephaestus's arms, laughed as his skull rattled.

Perhaps it was a natural result.

While the Outer Gods risked their lives to attack, the Constellations were only cautiously taking the offensive in order to avoid getting even a single wound.

Watching the Outer Gods' resistance, I did not lose hope. Just hold on a little longer. Even if it is a 'Giant Gate', even if this is the 'Fear Realm' without a scenario number, the aftershock of probability will not allow this kind of scenery to continue.

However, it seems that I was not the only one who thought that.

[Get out of the way.]

A voice that made my heart sink just by hearing it.

As Hephaestus shuddered and got out of the way, a giant trident pointed ahead.

「His play created the boundary of the sea.」

The moment the surging tale gave me goosebumps, a huge wave swept over the area.

I held on to Anna Croft and Yoo Joonghyuk and hid behind the severed leg of the 'Dream Eater'.

Kwaaaaaaaah!

The Fears that the 'King of Fear' had carefully collected were disappearing from the world one by one. The headless dragon, the Dream Eater, and the Founder of the Absolute Throne. The 'Fear' revealed under the brilliant starlight was no longer Fear. They were just vagabonds who had been kicked out of the scenario and lost their place.

Poseidon, the 'Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Sea' that had taken over Traiana, declared.

[Take care of it.]

The Constellations carrying the legend of the Giant Nebula on their backs began to slaughter the fleeing 'Outer Gods'.

I just stood there trembling in front of the scenery that made my imagination powerless.

What on earth could come to stop their tyranny?

Someone stood in front of the Outer Gods in my stead as I was just thinking.

The white, shining butterfly wings reflected the light pouring out from the Constellations.

[Stop it.]

Zeus, who had discovered the 'King of Fear', aimed at Astraphe once again. The battleship emitted light.

Kukuaquaquaquaqua!

It was a truly terrible bombing. It was a fierce attack on the Giant Gate where no living thing could survive. Even if he was Kim Dokja or the King of Fear, he couldn't withstand this attack.

"Damn, it hurts. Take it easy."

But there was someone who took the attack instead.

Between the scattered rays of light, the old man waved his blackened hands and clicked his tongue.

"Hehe, the Dream Eater I raised with great effort ended up like this."

The 'Dream Eater' who had fallen to the floor cried sadly. As the old man lightly patted the head of the Outer God and smiled bitterly, the boy who appeared next to him said.

"You can raise him again, old man."

"I'm saying this because it might take hundreds of years, you punk."

Those who resisted the starlight even in the midst of the hellish landscape. There were calm faces there, as if they had experienced this kind of disaster hundreds of times before.

[Transcendent Alliance.]

With Poseidon's words, the leaders of the Transcendent Alliance stood guard over the 'King of Fear'.

[Constellations, from here on out, I cannot allow it.]

Paradox Baekcheong Kyrgios.

[I wonder how many stars it takes to gather to form a 'Constellation'.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Master Namgung Minyoung.

[Hahahahaha! The day has finally come when I can fight you guys!]

Even Goryeo's best swordsman Cheok Jungyeong.

However, Zeus's expression, who was leading the way, did not waver even with the appearance of the Transcendents. Rather, a faint smile formed on Zeus' lips as if he was glad of their appearance.

[There are more sacrifices to place on the scale of probability.]

The Twelve Gods under Zeus rushed at the Transcendents.

Athena and Breaking the Sky Sword Master clashed, and Kyrgios and Hephaestus's weapons clashed. The First Sword of Goryeo, Cheok Jungyeong, and the fierce God of War Ares, fought each other's brute strength, firing their lion's roar.

When Zeus raised the holy relic 'Astrape', the warships began to fire again.

This time, the one who blocked the fire was Chunghuh, the Commander-in-Chief of the Transcendent Alliance and the God of Despair.

Zeus was annoyed by Chunghuh and said.

[Get out of the way. Mortals from another dimension, it’s not your place to get involved.]

"Hehe, I’m sorry, but I have no choice but to get involved."

Chunghuh continued, firmly blocking the way to King of Fear.

"If you destroy this 'Fear Realm', it will be difficult for us to maintain our existence."

Chunghuh said that and turned his head once more to look around.

Was it a coincidence? His eyes were staring straight at me, who had used 「Pebble and Me」.

Chunghuh nodded lightly at me.

"At least I can’t die yet. I just found out that the guy I really want to meet is alive."

Zeus seemed to no longer feel the need to talk, so he jumped down from the front and swung his spear himself.

Chunghuh, the God of Despair, bravely swung his sword in front of the Mythical Constellation’s action. The sky of the Fear Realm flashed like a giant light bulb, and ceaseless thunder struck the ground.

Even as his entire body burned black, the God of Despair was holding onto Zeus’s tale.

A terrifying fight. It was a fight I could not dare to get involved in. Nevertheless, on the one hand, I felt that I had to get involved.

Because I had the huge story I had gained from the 40th Time Fault.

「I have faced 'Zeus' before.」

I know that the situation is different now. I also know that the difference in class is absurdly severe.

Nevertheless, if only I could recreate that stage once more.

—Don’t think nonsense.

The one who stopped me was Cheok Jungyeong. While fighting against the ferocious God of War, Cheok Jungyeong was speaking to me through [Earth].

—It is not the time to use that yet. You cannot handle this fight.

I shook my head. I know that I am no help now. But...

—Disciple.

The moment I heard Cheok Jungyeong’s voice continuing, I realized that Cheok Jungyeong was very tired.

It wasn’t just him.

Kyrgios, Breaking the Sky Swords Saint, and the other Transcendents were also very tired.

Perhaps it was natural.

They had only recently returned from the 40th Round’s Time Fault with me.

I became anxious.

What should I do? What should I do to help them?

—There is something you must do.

As if reading my thoughts, Choi Jungyeong continued.

—Go and press the 'button'.

A button?

A memory suddenly came to mind.

When I first entered the End Zone and visited the 'Time Fault Room', I had seen a 'button' there.

The button at the top of the Time Fault.

0th Squad Captain Ryunard said this about that button.

「"Just press that. That's the 'reset' button of this 'End Zone'."」

The reset button of the end zone.

—If you press that button.

I saw Cheok Jungyeong's sword shatter under the spear swung by the ferocious God of War.

Cheok Jungyeong, whose belly was pierced, smiled at me and said.

—Everything that happened in the 'Fear Realm' will be 'as if it never happened'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 870 Episode 47 King of Fear (14)

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[The story, 'Pebble and I', stops talking.]

I couldn't hide any longer.

I left Yoo Joonghyuk to Anna and ran towards Cheok Jungyeong.

Cheok Jungyeong's eyes widened when he found me, and soon he smiled bitterly. He pulled out the spear from his stomach as if this level of injury was nothing and reached out to me.

[Go away!]

The gust of wind from his hand blew me away.

"Kim Dokja!"

Anna Croft shouted.

At the same time, the great Constellations of <Olympus> who had found me stepped forward with flags.

[It's a fragment of Kim Dokja!]

[Retrieve that guy too!]

<Olympus>'s goal was not just the 'King of Fear'. Having secured a large number of 'Kim Dokja fragments', I was also one of their targets for capture. I activated [Way of the Wind] and got away from them, briefly relaying the situation to Anna Croft.

Anna Croft listened to my story with a serious expression, then nodded as if she had made up her mind.

"If you press that 'button', you can stop the war."

"Theoretically, yes."

The 'reset button' of the Fear Realm is literally a button that reverses 'everything' that happened in the Fear Realm. If I could just press that button, the events here would go back to 'before the End'.

The problem is that I don't know when 'before the End' will be.

"I'll help you."

The Constellations' artillery fire passed by in front of my nose.

I asked, spitting out acrid smoke.

"Can you use [Future Sight]?"

"If it's short. I can't see too far into the future."

"That's enough."

Even in the desperate 40th Round, we somehow found a way. No matter how strong the Constellations of <Olympus> are, if we join forces, we can definitely overcome them.

"Over there!"

It would be fast if we flew with full force using [Way of the Wind], but in this situation, we couldn't do anything that would catch the eye.

"Turn to the right!"

I calmly followed Anna Croft's instructions. I pushed back the Constellations that rushed at me using [Way of the Wind] and [Baekcheong-ganggi], and when threatening

bombardments came flying, I knelt down next to the incarnations of the dead Constellations.

Kwakwakwakwakwa!

We ran through the thick smoke. We had to run a little faster.

We had to use the time that the King of Fear and the Captain-level Transcendental Constellations were giving us preciously.

Boom!

However, even with [Future Sight], we couldn't read all the bombardments. A blind shell flew towards us, and Anna Croft and I reflexively threw ourselves in a different direction. When I got up, covered in dust and coughing, I instinctively called out to Anna Croft.

"Anna."

Stories were flowing from her bloody legs.

Anna answered calmly.

—Kim Dokja, listen carefully. After all, the Constellations' targets are not me or the tyrant.

"But—"

—I will continue to relay the path through transmission. Go quickly.

Anna Croft hid behind the corpses of the Outer Gods that had exploded while carrying Yoo Joonghyuk.

I looked at Anna for a moment then bit my lips and started running.

Anna's voice filled my ears between the pouring artillery fire.

—Watch out for the back!

—They're flying in from the left!

—Ahead! There's a trap set right in front of you!

—Wait a minute there! Count to 5, then turn left and run!

I ran and ran, listening to the instructions without thinking.

How much time had passed like that? Finally, the exit of the 'Big House' began to come into view in the distance.

—From now on, it's straight ahead.

Straight ahead?

—Yes. We have to go straight ahead and break through.

I looked at the hundreds of Constellations blocking my path. They were the troops that <Olympus> had set up in advance, knowing that I would come toward the exit.

"How can I go straight ahead?"

However, Anna's voice could no longer be heard. What had happened? I hurriedly looked back, but Anna was nowhere to be seen.

Instead, what caught my eye was <Olympus>'s mythical Constellation, the 'Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Seas'.

Kukukukukukukuku.

Poseidon was pounding the floor with his Tryana. Every time the floor and the spearhead collided, the surrounding atmosphere swirled and tore apart the Outer Gods.

「Transmission is basically a technique that transmits sound by carrying it through compressed air. If the air in the area was controlled by Poseidon, it was only natural that Anna's Echo would not be transmitted.」

[Catch them.]

At Poseidon's command, Jason, Achilles, and other great Constellations rushed toward me.

Anna said. Break through them.

Then that meant I had a way to break through them. I thought I knew how. The story I had accumulated while experiencing a series of events in the Fear Realm was telling me how.

[The story, 'Friend of Fear', begins its storytelling.]

As the story began its storytelling, my confidence surged.

[It's over there! Catch them!]

The great Constellations' spears flew in, taking advantage of the gap I had paused.

I took a deep breath and thought.

This is the 'Big House' of the Fear Realm.

With the power of the 'Great King of Fear', all kinds of 'Fear' had gathered here.

[Use story fragment, 'Remote Signal Controller'.]

Of course, there were Fears that I had cleared.

[Catastrophic Fear, 'Alien Signal Light' is activated!]

The light of the signal light that was flashing in the distance changed, and the Constellations that were chasing after me screamed with a loud noise.

[Kwaaaaah! What the!]

I started running, leaving behind the terrible crashing sound that was pushing me forward and backward.

[The Constellation 'Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Sea' expresses its anger at you!]

I felt a dreary gaze from behind me, then the Triana's spear passed by me with a dizzying sensation.

The spear created a strong wind and blew away the 'Alien Signal Light' in the area.

Damn it.

[Enough! Chase him!]

I still had a long way to the exit. I thought I should activate [Way of the Wind] and fly away instead. Even if it draws some of their attention, if you want to run the shortest distance quickly, it’s better to fly here—

[Kuaaaaak!]

[What the hell—]

I heard the Constellations that were rushing toward me from the front being torn apart. It sounded like a shrimp’s back being crushed between whales.

When I blinked my eyes stupidly, there was a guy who really looked like a whale.

【Ooooooooooooo!】

A cry that tore through my ears.

It was the 'Fear' I knew.

[Natural Disaster-level Fear, 'Tooth Fin', roars!]

Tooth Fin.

It was the 'Shark Head' I had met at the entrance to the Fear Realm.

Every time the guy swung his tail once, five or six Great-level Constellations would fall.

"You… have become a 'Natural Disaster-level'!"

I shouted happily, and the guy flicked his fin once. It seemed to tell me to get on.

I climbed on the guy's back without hesitation. As the streamlined giant body writhed, the surrounding scenery began to rush forward.

[Don't miss it.]

Poseidon once again drew the floor with his spear. The sea boundary split and the waves that rose from the crater covered our rear like a tsunami.

However, Poseidon's choice was a mistake.

This guy was 'Tooth Fin'. The fear that ruled the Sea of Fear.

Following the sharp surge of the waves, Tooth Fin accelerated even more and arrived at the exit of the 'Big House' in an instant.

'Tooth Fin' blocked the exit with its huge body and stopped the Constellations chasing me.

"Thank you."

【Teeth Teeth Teeth Teeth Teeth Teeth Teeth】

After greeting the guy whose teeth were chattering, I slid down the streamlined back and opened the exit door. As I stepped out of the door, I saw the 'Time Fault Room' in shambles. I looked straight up.

The top of the 'Time Fault Room'.

[1863-99th round.]

Next to the Time Fault sign that said so, I saw a small button. It was the 'reset button' I was looking for.

Quaddududduk.

I heard something creaking inside the door of the 'Big House'.

Then, a terrible thunder echoed.

There was no time.

I immediately used [Way of the Wind] and soared into the sky. Fortunately, there was no Constellation to catch me, so it didn't take long for me to reach the top of the room.

Finally, there was a button in front of me. If I press this button, I can stop this tragedy.

But at that moment.

—Are you really going to make all that 'thing' as if it 'never happened'?

There was a voice echoing in my head. It was a voice I knew well.

"Cheon Inho."

—If you press that button, the King of Fear will survive. But all the stories you've built will disappear.

I hesitated and asked.

"How do you know that?"

—If you don't want to believe it, just think of it as the nonsense of the 'Evil Sophist'.

Suddenly, something occurred to me.

The Evil Sophist, Cheon Inho. He was one of the few 'Recorders of Fear' in this 'Fear Realm'. So it wouldn't be particularly strange if he knew the secrets of this 'Fear Realm'.

—As a Recorder, I'll give you some advice. If you press that button, all the events here will revert to the moment the 'Transcendent Alliance' was created. All the stories you've built since entering the 'Fear Realm' will disappear, and the reason you came here will become meaningless. And crucially.

Cheon Inho added with a smirk.

—If you press that button, your survival cannot be guaranteed.

Zeus's thunder was growing louder.

—The moment you press the button, all impurities that are not necessary for the initial components of the 'Fear Realm' will be removed.

"I can't believe what you say."

Regardless of whether Cheon Inho's words were true or false, if you don't press this button, all the characters in the 'Big House' will die. Kyrgios, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, and Cheok Jungyeong will all die.

It was the moment I finally put my hand on the button after taking a deep breath. With a hazy scent brushing my nose, someone grabbed my wrist.

Shining butterfly wings. It was the King of Fear.

His once brilliant wings were more than half torn off, and his body was covered in wounds from weapons.

His skin was horribly protruding.

From his shoulders to his waist, there were traces of Zeus's lightning striking him, and below, there were scars from Poseidon's waves. Snowdrops flowed like tears from his tattered feet.

In that state, the King of Fear called me.

【■■-ah.】

He was calling my name, which he had never called before.

【Don't do that.】

Why? His voice sounded normal. For a long time, [Multispecies Communication] was maintained.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', is activated.]

Or is this also a function of [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]?

His inner thoughts, which had been stained with incomprehension, suddenly became clear. Maybe it was because the Fear Realm had come to an end.

It might be evidence that he was no longer the 'King of Fear'.

【Don't press the button.】

I shook my head and shouted.

If I don't press this button, you will die. The people of the Transcendent Alliance and the Outer Gods will all die.

Everything you loved will turn to dust and disappear.

You will be torn to pieces by those damn Constellations who want the 'Kim Dokja fragments'.

So this is the only way to protect the 'Fear Realm'.

Return to before I entered this 'Fear Realm', before all the incidents occurred.

Then the King of Fear said.

【No.】

Kim Dokja, who loves the stories of this world more than anyone else, smiled at me and said.

【I like your stories too.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 871 Episode 47 King of Fear (15)

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I like your story.

Kim Dokja's words left deep ripples in my heart.

Some words make me realize that I wanted to hear them all along after hearing them.

I looked into his face.

His name was Kim Dokja. A character I wrote about in 551 chapters.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', becomes more powerfully activated.]

I could tell what he was thinking just by looking at his expression.

【The Fear Realm will be destroyed. I'll call a train, so get out of here.】

"That can't be."

The King of Fear looked back silently. An eerie light was continuously flowing out from beyond the doorway of the 'Big House'. It was Zeus's tale.

Beyond that, the screams of the Transcendents were scattered. I could also hear the sound of the Toothy Fins howling in pain.

"Let's get out of here together."

Why he liked my story, maybe I knew.

The Second Kim Dokja, who had been hiding in the 'Fear Realm' since the moment he was born.

In a sense, this 'Fear Realm' was another 'Snowfield' for Kim Dokja.

He must have hidden between the lines, collecting Fears, and reading and rereading the stories he had already read.

The Second Kim Dokja stared at me with calm eyes.

【You know what will happen if I leave here.】

The Second Kim Dokja made a light gesture, and a small screen rose into the air.

—It's been destroyed!

—The disaster has fallen!

His shards that had advanced into the scenario were dying after being attacked by the incarnations. His butterfly wings were torn, and the 'Nameless Things' that protected him collapsed.

【Not only me, but the 'Gods of the Other World' will suffer the same thing every time. As long as this <Star Stream> exists.】

"So you tried to make the <Star Stream> itself a 'Fear Realm'?"

The King of Fear smiled brightly.

【Failed, but.】

It was bound to fail.

In this world where someone's sorrow is simply a story, he who entered the scenario will only become a disaster. All the stars and incarnations will gather their strength to drive him out, and then plant a brilliant flag of victory in the place where his sorrow was.

【Still, it had to be done.】

"Why did it have to be now? Is it because I read the 'Prophecy of the End'?"

I thought of the 'Prophecy of the End' I had read when I entered the 'Transcendent Alliance'.

「The Fears that have begun to be recorded will return to being stories. They will become established stories. They will be written down in history again.」

When that day comes, the boundary of sleep will open, and the King of Fear will descend.

And only the one who defeats the King of Fear will become the last storyteller who denies all records at the boundary between dreams and reality.」

The 'Prophecy of the End' that hinted at the birth and death of the 'King of Fear'. The King of Fear looked at me quietly and shook his head.

【Everything is already written, and is being written at the same time.】

The King of Fear muttered those words lowly and then quietly added.

【The current 'Fear Realm' cannot accommodate all the Outer Gods. It was going to happen eventually. The prophecy was just a trigger.】

"But—"

【Go away. With your colleagues.】

As the King of Fear reached out, Anna Croft and Yoo Joonghyuk, who had fainted inside the doorway of the 'Big House', came out floating in the air.

I caught them with both hands and spoke again.

"I won't go. No, I can't go."

The King of Fear looked at me for a moment as if he was frustrated. I heard the sound of lighting flashing from behind me once again.

【There's no time. If you keep refusing, I'll absorb you.】

The moment I met his compound eyes, my heart pounded loudly. An uncomfortable aura flowed from his appearance as he approached step by step.

【I will absorb you and take all of your stories. I will gather the fragments and dye the <Star Stream> in Fear. I will create a world where everyone fears each other and no one can harm each other.】

At the same time, story stirred inside me.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', growls.]

I answered with my eyes narrowed.

"If you can, try. But I will never leave you alone."

【There's nothing I can do.】

The next moment, the King of Fear opened his mouth wide. The distant darkness inside his mouth greedily overflowed.

【You brought this upon yourself.】

The darkness swallowed me up.

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rlaehrwk37: What? What happened?

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The King of Fear opened his eyes.

The power of stories welling up inside him. The King of Fear took several calming breaths as if to calm his power.

How long did he continue breathing like that? The 'Time Fault Room' began to shake dangerously.

[The Constellation, 'Lightning Seat', manifests its own power!]

Finally, Zeus's incarnation reached the doorway of the 'Big House'.

Of course, Zeus was not the only one to appear.

【Ooooooooh!】

This is the 'Time Fault' Room!

The 'Divine Beings of the Other World' began to come in earnest through the entrances of countless Time Faults.

Catastrophe, Disaster, Natural Disaster.

A legion of Fear that could literally destroy this world.

Following that, Zeus's lightning spear Astraphe appeared beyond the doorway of the 'Big House'. It seemed as if pure white electricity was dyeing the sky, and in the next moment, the entire space was cleanly annihilated. Fragments of the stories of the fallen Outer Gods hovered around the 'Time Fault' room. The angry Outer Gods screamed.

【Ah... So, changing the history of this 'worldline'.】

[You probably know that you have no choice now.]

Even Jang Hayoung, who cleared the 1,864th round, could not stop their fleet.

In front of the overwhelming power of the <Olympus> fleet led by Zeus, there were only two choices.

Surrender here and be subject to <Olympus>, or disappear with the Fear Realm.

The King of Fear said.

【You guys, it seems you have forgotten where this place is.】

[Even if this is your dream, you cannot stop us.]

Poseidon laughed, as if he had already figured out the power of the 'King of Fear'.

[I know that all you can do is 'dream' to maintain this place.]

The most powerless god in this world.

The 'King of Fear' governs everything in the 'Fear Realm', but he cannot do anything alone.

【That's right. It's a sad story.】

The 'King of Fear' laughed. It was a laugh that was both a sneer and a self-mockery.

With that laugh on his face, the 'King of Fear' said,

【Youngest.】

He called me.

【Remember the end of this story well.】

As expected, I was not absorbed by the 'King of Fear'.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', is activating.]

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint activated at a dramatic moment.]

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', stage 0 is activating.]

「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint stage 0 that has never been activated. As a result of that stage 0, I was now seeing the world through the eyes of the King of Fear without being absorbed by him.」

[You're bluffing.]

The moment Poseidon aimed Traiana at the King of Fear, the Outer Gods of the 'Time Fault' simultaneously began to howl toward the sky.

The wailing soon covered the entire 'Fear Realm', and soon became a tale.

「A Giant Tale.」

It was a Giant Tale that turned the King of Fear into 'Kim Dokja'.

[The Giant Tale, 'Season of Light and Darkness', begins its storytelling.]

With a sound of tsutsutsu, the scenery of the battlefield began to change.

「Staging.」

It was unbelievable.

In order for 'Staging' to occur, the conditions for the stage to be established must be met.

For example, 「Season of Light and Darkness」 is a tale that occurred on the 'Island of Reincarnation'.

The story that was born when <Eden> and <Demon World> clashed, causing the 'Great War of the Holy Demons', with Kim Dokja leading to the conclusion of it was 「Season of Light and Darkness」.

But now, this place was not the 'Island of Reincarnation', and there were no Constellations representing good and evil.

The only one here was 'Kim Dokja'.

But how.

[What nonsense—]

It seems that Poseidon and Zeus had the same doubts as me.

「The ruins of the 'Holy Demon War' were spread out there.」

How could the 'Holy Demon War' be recreated here?

[There are no Archangels or Demon Kings here! But how...!]

The answer was simple.

【There are no Archangels or Demon Kings here?】

[What?]

【It's not that you can't see it?】

The Constellations of <Olympus>, including Poseidon, still had faces that they didn't understand.

Only I understood what he was saying.

I sighed and admired, and groaned and despaired. The scenery that I could see because of [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] 'Stage 0' was activated. When did it start?

「The forgotten Archangels and Demon Kings stood beside us.」

No one would call them 'Archangels' or 'Demons' anymore. They had lost their names.

【Goodandevilgoodandevilgoodandevilgoodandevilgoodandevilgoodandevil】

【Lightanddarknesslightanddarknesslight
anddarknesslightanddarknesslightanddarknesslightanddarkness】

But there was a time when they also existed in the scenario. There were days when they faced their own battlefield with their own roles.

The old story—their legend, which could only be preserved through the 'Time Fault', was now being released as a 「stage」 here.

【Ohohohohohoh!】

On the stage, I could see the scenery that the 'King of Fear' had been guarding alone.

Only then did I understand the reason for the existence of the Time Fault, and I understood why Outer Gods keep hiding in the gap of the Time Fault.

They have been constantly wandering in search of their lost story and lost hometown.

Poseidon roared and shouted.

[The stage alone is useless. With just that 'Giant Tale'—]

[You don't know what kind of war the 'Holy War' is awakening.]

The 'King of Fear' who said that was truly like Kim Dokja.

[Well, it's not your history.]

Kim Dokja who led the 'Holy War' that day, in that place.

Kim Dokja in history who protected <Kim Dokja's Company> with his own sacrifice.

Kugugugugugu!

The loud noise was heard from the door far above.

「1863-99th round」

The unknown 'Time Fault' next to the 'reset button'.

Beyond the doorway of that Fault, something terrible was rippling.

[Spear That Draws the Boundary of the Sea, what is happening!]

The Twelve Gods of <Olympus> who came through the door late stood as if protecting the Mythical-grade Constellations. However, Zeus and Poseidon simply stared at the 'Time Fault' on the ceiling with bewitched faces.

Among the Twelve Gods, the first to notice the situation was the Blacksmith of the Volcano—Hephaestus.

[Oh my god, that crazy guy right now—]

Only then did they realize what kind of being the 'original form of the outsider' was beyond that doorway.

The shadow of a giant tail swinging beyond the portal of the Time Fault.

「There was the 'Calamity of the Stars'.」

I realized once again that this place was the 'Fear Realm'.

The Fears of this world were classified into several categories.

Catastrophe level, Disaster level, Natural Disaster level.

But there was one more level of classification above these.

End of the story.

A Fear that could possibly threaten this entire <Star Stream>.

[You, if you do that, you won't be safe either! Everyone here will die!]

The cries of the Constellations were colorless, and the King of Fear slowly raised his hand and called out the Fear.

【Come.】

Chunghuh had said something like that. The Fear of the end is not a 'Fear that can be avoided'.

It is a Fear that 'can only be accepted'.

That Fear was now awakening under the protection of the Giant Tale.

I also knew that Fear. In Han Sooyoung's 'Guide to Fear Realm that Even a Squid and Sunfish Can Understand', the name of that 'Fear' is given as follows:

「Type 1 End-of-the-Story Fear.」

The prototype of that Fear is as follows:

「The Last Dragon of the Apocalypse.」

I could feel the shadow of a giant tail shaking beyond the doorway.

Everyone here knew. That one tail flick would make everything about this 'Fear Realm' disappear.

Tsutsutsutsut!

The aftermath of probability finally began to blow. With the appearance of the last dragon, the 'balance of probability' was completely shattered.

In the center of the Fear Realm that was rushing in with pure white sparks, the god who was more omniscient and incompetent than anyone else spoke.

【As you said, all I can do is 'dream'. But.】

The god's finger pointed at the <Olympus> fleet.

【You are also in my dream.】

Finally, the last dragon's tail moved.

【I always have nightmares.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 872 Episode 47 King of Fear (16)

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How long did the King of Fear have to endure for this moment?

It was a terrible, beautiful, natural, and mysterious dream. A nightmare that finally announced the end of a world. An endless darkness that no starlight dared to reveal its origin.

In that darkness, the last tail moved.

[Kim Dokja!]

Jang Hayoung, who had come through the doorway late, screamed. However, her voice was buried in the story of the Giant Tale and could not be heard.

The King of Fear's finger fell from above, and the tail of the last dragon sank in response.

[The Giant Tale, 'Season of Light and Darkness', is recreated!]

The last tail fluttered with a loud noise. The first shock wave passed through the doorway of the Time Fault.

I watched the scene through [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] Stage 0. The time that the King of Fear had endured to dream this dream passed through my soul.

[The story, 'King of Fear', begins its storytelling.]

At that moment, I was the King of Fear, and the King of Fear was me.

Kim Dokja, who had dreamed for a long time in a 'Big House' that was so small compared to the world he had dreamed of.

「"Hayoung-ah."」

And there was a fighter who had been by his side.

「"Will I be able to have a happy dream someday?"」

Even he, who loved sadness more than anyone else, actually wanted to have a happy dream.

But he did not know what a 'happy dream' was. He had forgotten what it was, and perhaps had not learned it.

Jang Hayoung said to him.

「"Dreaming a happy dream is not important."」

Stroking the head of the boy who had now forgotten what happiness meant, Jang Hayoung told him an old story.

「"The important thing is to be alive now."」

Jang Hayoung also did not know what happiness was.

However, she had long-scribbled sentences on the wall.

Precious sentences that she had written down one by one on the unidentified wall—the 「Wall of Impossible Communication」—hoping that someone would read them again someday.

She was reading those sentences again after a long time. She was reading the sentences that she had hoped someone would read.

Helping Aileen at the clock shop Etica ("Actually, I don’t know much about clocks.").

The taste of the 'Devil’s Stir-Fried Tripe of the Ruined Lodge' made by Chef Marc ("You’ll regret not eating it if you only look at its appearance.").

The day she first encountered Kim Dokja in the world of terrible scenarios ("Some bastard threw a shoulder punch at me…").

The moment when time began to flow again in the Demon World that had stopped ("It was so frustrating.").

The memory of her, who had been pessimistic about her talents her whole life, blossoming for the first time and becoming Kim Dokja's 'fighter'. ("It was so overwhelming at that time.").

The time when people who were not given any roles in the scenario could all become 'Kim Dokja' at the same time, shouting 'revolution'. ("I will probably never forget it.").

Jang Hayoung talked about all those things as if they were troubled, sad, or happy.

Kim Dokja listened to the story silently, nodded, and asked.

「"Is that happiness?"」

Jang Hayoung was silent for a moment, then smiled faintly and answered.

「"I don't know."」

「"Why are you telling me that?"」

「"I want you to live."」

The moment the story took a deep breath, he disappeared.

[The story, 'King of Fear', ends its storytelling.]

The King of Fear spoke to Jang Hayoung, the fighter who was shouting from afar.

【I'm sorry. I couldn't keep my promise until the end.】

The shock wave of the tail wagging, approaching and crushing the entire upper part of the 'Time Fault Room'. According to the main story, the 'first tail strike' of the 'Final Dragon' destroyed a quarter of the <Star Stream>.

The tail strike consisted of a total of three shock waves, and the 'shock wave' approaching now was the 'first shock wave'.

At that moment, Zeus's Astraphe aimed at the sky. The <Olympus> fleet, which had finished lining up its troops, was waiting for orders.

[Fire.]

Dozens of ships simultaneously fired their flash cannons.

A magical cannon containing the great legend of <Olympus>.

The great power contained in each shot swept away the nearby Outer Gods and collided with the shock wave of the 'Final Dragon'.

Kukukukukukukuku!

However, despite that relentless barrage, the shock wave did not take any damage at all.

The end was approaching slowly and steadily.

The faces of the Twelve Gods who confirmed the wave darkened.

[How could that be…!]

That was the power of the 'Final Dragon'. It was the disaster of the <Star Stream> that ended the 'Great Battle of the Holy Demon'.

Even so, there was a way to stop that tail slap.

Kim Dokja in the main story blocked that shockwave.

「The first shockwave of the tail slap is made up of 'lightning'.」

Considering the lineup of Constellations that had withstood the shockwave in the main story, Zeus, a Myth-grade Constellation that controlled 'lightning', was qualified to block that first shockwave.

Even so, Zeus's judgment was as follows.

[Withdraw.]

A portal opened in the air and the ships began to move backward.

In that brief moment, Zeus made his judgment.

Even if he could offset the 'first shockwave', it would be difficult to fully handle the power of the Final Dragon here.

Even if he could handle it, he probably thought it would be more harmful than beneficial.

It was a cowardly but wise choice.

Because.

Tsutsutsutsutsut!

Immediately after the tail wagging began, everything in the Fear Realm began to be swept away by the aftermath of probability.

【Ahahahahah!】

A space that is not strange even if its existence is broken at any time.

If it were a normal Constellation, they wouldn't want to stay in this area for a minute or a second.

[The 'Fragments of the Oldest Dream' to be pushed.]

Zeus, who was hiding behind the portal, looked back at this side for the last time.

[<Olympus> will definitely take back our ■■.]

At the end of these words, the presence of Zeus and the Twelve Gods completely disappeared.

[The Giant Nebula, <Olympus>, suffered a huge blow and leaves the 'Fear Realm'.]

I had a bitter smile in my heart.

After making things like this, they're going to run away.

Still, with this, <Olympus>'s giant story would have been hit hard.

No matter how much the 'scale of probability' was broken, the power that Zeus used in the 'Fear Realm' was the power that was suitable for the final chapter of the scenarios.

Maybe this time they should step down from the 3 Great Nebulae.

By the way, what will happen to us if this happens?

<Olympus> disappeared, but the shock wave left by the 'first tail slap' was still hitting us.

【Ooooooooooo!】

The terrified Outer Gods were each running away to different 'Time Faults'.

I thought it would be a good idea to call Jaehwan again, but as Jang Hayoung said, there was no way to call him now.

It meant that from now on, we had to block that shock wave with our own strength.

In the main story, there were four Constellations that blocked that 'tail slap'.

Thor and Dionysus, Kim Dokja who activated [Electrification], and Kyrgios. Only after they joined forces did they manage to block the 'first shockwave'.

However, there was no Thor or Dionysus here.

What was here was...

[Seeing that guy finally woke up, it seems my disciple failed.]

When I looked back, I saw that Cheok Jungyeong was looking this way with his eyes wide open. Fortunately, the leaders of the 'Transcendence Alliance' seemed to have survived.

[But it's too early to give up.]

Kyrgios, who escaped from the big house, activated [Incarnation] and rose into the sky while emitting a Transcendental energy.

[There is a 'Paradox' here.']

With a 'Kudduk' sound, the white-blue lightning he emitted began to offset the shockwave.

Kugugugugu.

But it was too much for him alone. Even though he was one of the leaders of the 'Transcendence Alliance', if only one Transcendence could block the 'first shockwave', the last dragon wouldn't have been called a disaster.

Fortunately, he wasn't alone.

[Eeeeeeeeeeeeee]

The King of Transcendents, Jang Hayoung, who activated [Electrification], rushed towards the burning Kyrgios.

Following them, unknown Outer Gods joined them.

【Ooooooooooo!】

Is this an illusion?

At first glance, the backs of the Outer Gods fighting the dragons looked exactly like Thor and Dionysus.

As expected, Jang Hayeong, whose entire body began to burn black, turned around and shouted.

[Kim Dokja! Close the door! Quickly!]

A thought suddenly occurred to me after hearing those words.

The reason why the tail of 'Apocalypse Dragon' had covered the Fear Realm was because the 'King of Fear' had opened the door to the 'Time Fault'. Then, on the contrary, if only the King of Fear could close that door once more—

「The King of Fear cannot close the 'door'.」

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' stage 0 is released.]

「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint was released, and the King of Fear sneezed violently into the air. I came out of his mouth with sticky mucus.」

【Youngest.】

I opened my eyes in my incarnation body with a slight dizziness. The dazzlingly burning King of Fear was before my eyes.

I knew why he was calling me.

He was Kim Dokja, who only had the most horrible dreams. In order to summon 'Apocalypse Dragon', he had just squandered all the probability he had.

【I cannot close that 'door'.】

He cannot stop his nightmare.

【The train will come soon, and I will put you and the children on that train. So that you can evacuate far away from this 'Fear Realm'.】

Even until the very last moment, he was worried about others, not himself.

"Are you giving up like this? We've come this far. We can do it! It's a disaster you've called, so you can get rid of it. So—"

The King of Fear shook his head as if dismissing my words.

【Even though I've been dreaming for so long, the only dreams I can have are nightmares.】

"But."

【Maybe except for one dream.】

The King of Fear, who had lightly glanced at the entirety of the Fear Realm, looked back at me for the last time.

It was a truly suffocating gaze. I stumbled, unable to bear that gaze.

【Perhaps this moment.】

When I first met the 'King of Fear', I thought he was a little scary. But damn it, at this moment, I thought his appearance was beautiful.

I thought that his appearance, risking everything to protect everyone else, was more like Kim Dokja than any other Kim Dokja I knew.

【This is probably why I've been dreaming all this time.】

A horn sounded from afar. A familiar train running on the tracks.

The sound of wheels.

A subway was approaching from afar.

「Subway on the way home from work.」

The train that brought us into this terrible scenario world.

【Thank you for giving me a good dream, Youngest.】

And yet, that train was the only salvation that could save us from hell at this moment.

"Let's go together."

I said, holding his hand tightly. Then, the King of Fear shook his head.

【That can't be. I am the 'Fear Realm' itself.】

"If you die here, all the dreams you've collected will disappear, right?"

【...】

"There is one way."

I finished speaking, looking back and forth between the shockwave that was now right in front of me and the train rushing toward me from afar.

"There is a way to avoid the 'End' without any of this Fear Realm disappearing."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 873 Episode 47 King of Fear (17)

【A way to avoid the 'End' without any Fear disappearing.】

The King of Fear smiled bitterly as if pointing out the unreality of my words.

【You're also a helpless Kim Dokja.】

In fact, I think it would have been the same for any Kim Dokja, not just me.

If any Kim Dokja knew what the King of Fear was thinking, any Kim Dokja would have made the same choice as me.

A spark of probability flew out of the air again. The train running from afar was caught in the net of probability and couldn't come over.

Perhaps the <Star Stream> was blocking the train.

The train was forcing the probability of the end so that the 'King of Fear' couldn't get on board and so that he couldn't escape this world.

One fortunate thing is that the probability doesn't apply to anyone else except him. Due to the strong aftershock, the tail of the 'Final Dragon' also slowed down significantly.

Now was the perfect time to escape the Fear Realm.

[Everyone, get on the train! Hurry up!]

As Jang Hayoung, who was enduring the tail of the Final Dragon on the front line, shouted, the Outer Gods and the Transcendents who couldn't escape through the 'Time Fault' began to board the train one by one.

Watching the residents of the Fear Realm hurriedly evacuating, the King of Fear opened his mouth.

【I can't get on that, but you and your friends are different. You can get on that and escape even now.】

"I won't get on it."

The King of Fear looked at me blankly and then asked.

【Do you know what that means?】

"I know."

There is only one way to end this apocalypse without anything in this Fear Realm disappearing.

"We'll become one Kim Dokja."

I will take over his story and close the door of the 'Time Fault' that Apocalypse Dragon is trying to cross.

【You might fail. You might just die a dog's death.】

"No, I can do it."

It might not be possible alone, but it can be done with two. If we combine the power of the 'Kim Dokja fragments' that the two of us possess, if we combine our imaginations that even <Olympus> coveted, it will definitely be possible.

And above all.

"I also dream well."

I can't be sure whether the dream we create is the dream that the 'King of Fear' wanted.

But at least it will be a fun dream.

[The Constellation, 'Goryeo’s First Sword', is watching your choice.]

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', is watching your choice.]

[The Constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', is watching your choice.]

…

The dream that the stars in the sky that are still watching this story like.

[The Constellation, 'Father of the Rich Night', is watching your choice.]

The Father of the 'Underworld', who had not appeared until now, was also looking into the Fear Realm. Maybe he had heard news of <Olympus> and came to visit.

Either way, it would not be bad for them to see this story. The more Constellations see this stage, the bigger the scale of the 'Giant Tale' we would obtain if we completed this stage.

The King of Fear, who was looking up at the Constellations in the sky with me, said.

【I thought dreams were always dreamed alone.】

The King of Fear, who reached out to me, was already on the verge of falling apart. The Second Kim Dokja, grabbed my hand tightly with his weak hand.

I felt his story flowing into the hand I was holding. It was a story that encompassed the entirety of the 'Fear Realm'.

【No matter what kind of dream it is, this is our farewell, Youngest.】

The moment I saw his weak expression, an intense hunger boiled inside me. When you become 'One Kim Dokja', one Kim Dokja is absorbed by the other Kim Dokja.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', mocks your will.]

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', opens its mouth as if he had been waiting!]

I calmed down the story with firm patience and said.

"What are you talking about?"

It was certainly as he said. Normally, two fragments should be combined to become 'One Kim Dokja'.

But there was something he still didn't know.

"You still don't know what a happy dream is."

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

Instead of absorbing the story of the 'King of Fear', I started to let his story flow through the [Fourth Wall].

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is recording the story.]

[Trait, 'Record Repairer', is activated!]

[Your lost records are starting to be repaired.]

The 'King of Fear', who realized what I was doing, opened his eyes wide.

I smiled at him and added.

"At least until you find out—"

The story flowed through my blood vessels like an electric current. For a moment, my consciousness became dizzy and then returned.

"You should stay with me until we find out what our 'happiness' is."

The situation was definitely different from the 'First Kim Dokja'.

The story I had to copy to the [Fourth Wall] now was no different than this entire 'Fear Realm'.

[The aftershock of probability is coming!]

I saw Jang Hayoung, who noticed our change, shouting in my direction from afar.

But no one, including Jang Hayoung, could approach me. The net of probability that wrapped us tightly did not allow it.

As if the current was getting faster, the story of the Fear Realm began to be conveyed to me at an increasingly faster rate.

「The beginning and end of a world were there.」

The Nameless ones that had visited the Fear Realm and the memories of the Outer Gods. The voices of the Transcendental gods. The Constellations' contempt all flowed into me.

And deep within that tale was the words of a great being.

「【Are you the 'King of Fear'?】」

Judging from the level felt in the true words, it was the voice of an Outer God that may be equivalent to the 'end of the word'.

「【If you thought you could lock us up in such a flimsy 'house', you were mistaken.】」

Even as my consciousness became hazy, I tried not to miss the words of the stories that I was hearing.

「【Your efforts are admirable, so I will wait a little longer.】」

「【Remember, baby.】」

「【You can’t stop the apocalypse just because you’re blocking us.】」

I couldn’t even guess which Outer Gods were giving advice.

I wonder if there’s something the 'King of Fear' hasn’t told me about the 'Fear Realm'.

「【Remember. You were the ones who stole our 'story' first.】」

I felt something inside me slowly expanding like a dam overflowing. I was starting to feel suffocated, and my breathing was starting to become difficult.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', warns you!]

In the end, even the [Fourth Wall] had reached its limit.

I thought that maybe this might happen, but it happened too quickly.

Unlike the [Fourth Wall] that Kim Dokja had, the [Fourth Wall] that I had was still incomplete.

【Youngest.】

My library was too small to copy the stories of the King of Fear without any damage.

【Let go.】

I didn’t let go.

If I hold on a little longer, I can know your truth. I can know what you’re hiding. Maybe I can understand you. And so,

「I can save you.」

But the next moment, my consciousness became hazy as if something in my head was cut off.

【Youngest.】

In my fading consciousness, I heard the urgent voice of the Second Kim Dokja calling me. A voice that sounded distant, as if he was deep in thought.

【…!】

In the raging sparks, our two incarnation bodies were slowly disappearing.

And then, a small portal appeared behind the 'King of Fear'.

What appeared in the portal was a pure white hand.

Knowing what it was, I tried to tell the 'King of Fear' to avoid it.

You shouldn’t be caught by that hand. Then you too will disappear like the other 'kkoma Kim Dokjas'.

The moment the hand that moved quickly grabbed the 'King of Fear's' nape, the King of Fear looked back. When on earth did he notice? The King of Fear was holding the white hand with the other hand that was holding my hand.

【I'm sorry, but I can't give it to you.】

It was as if he knew the identity of the 'white hand.'

—Dreams are meant to be dreamed alone. So let's go to a place where you can dream alone. With me.

【No.】

—Why did you change your mind now?

【I don't know.】

The King of Fear stared at me silently and then added.

【If you don't know that, it'll be hard for you to collect all the 'Kim Dokja fragments' forever.】

The white hand that stopped at those words let out a mischievous laugh and said.

—That's why I hate 'Kim Dokja.'

A blinding white light burst out, and the King of Fear's painful groan could be heard. The sparks surrounding the surroundings gradually decreased.

As soon as my consciousness returned, I opened my mouth.

"King of Fear."

I did not hear an answer.

"Kim Dokja!"

His hand that was holding mine was nowhere to be seen.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', stops recording.]

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', is licking his lips.]

I couldn't figure out what was happening.

I briefly lost consciousness, a white hand appeared, and the white hand and the 'King of Fear' talked.

And when I came to my senses, the 'King of Fear' was gone.

[You have achieved the impossible feat!]

[The Great Dokkaebi of the Management Bureau is watching your presence!]

[Your 'Myth Tale' evolves once again!]

[Your Tale holds the possibility of a 'Giant Tale'!]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> begins to move!]

I couldn't be happy about the messages that came one after another.

A train horn was heard from afar. The train carrying the Outer Gods and the Transcendents was finally ready to leave.

[Kim Dokja! Run away quickly! I can't hold out any longer—]

Jang Hayoung, who was still blocking the last tail wagging at the front line, shouted at me.

But I couldn't move.

If the Great King of Fear had disappeared like this, or if he had been kidnapped by the 'White Hand'—that is, by Asmodeus...

Woow.

That was when I felt a vibration in my arms. My phone was ringing in my pocket. I answered the phone without hesitation.

—You crazy bastard!

It was the voice of the First Kim Dokja, the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

"What happened?"

—What happened! Do you know what happened to this place because of you?

"You all watched. What happened to the King of Fear!"

The Demon King of Salvation closed his mouth at my urgent voice. After a moment of ominous silence, the Demon King of Salvation let out a deep sigh.

He said.

—The Second one came in safely.

I also let out a sigh of relief.

—But there must have been some damage to the story on the way in, because he’s still unconscious…

"Story loss?"

—Anyway, he came in safely. No, more than that, do you know what you did? Right now…!

"Please help me."

—Huh?

What happened inside [Fourth Wall] was an important issue, but what was more important was the incident unfolding before our eyes. The aftermath of probability was dying down, and Apocalypse Dragon’s shockwave was now reaching us.

—Can’t you just get on the train and run away?

"If I run away, what about that person?"

I looked up at the being who was still blocking the shockwave in front of me.

Kim Dokja’s fighter.

The being who swore to protect Kim Dokja’s side no matter what happened.

"Jang Hayoung will die."

Jang Hayoung never got on the train. Maybe she had decided that this place was her ■■.

Even if she had blocked the first shockwave, Apocalypse Dragon's shockwave was three stages in total.

"We have to close the door. Is there no other way?"

At first, I tried to control the Time Fault of the 'Fear Realm' by borrowing the power of the 'King of Fear'.

However, I couldn't properly exercise any power on the Fear Realm because I had not properly absorbed him but had put him in the [Fourth Wall], or because he was unconscious.

In other words, if this continued, I would inevitably be hit by Apocalypse Dragon's tail and go to the underworld.

—Well, if you insist on closing it, there's nothing you can't do.

"How?"

—You spoke confidently to the Second, but didn't you have another plan?

"My plan is you."

I said with a grin.

"Please tell me quickly. Otherwise, you might get killed if I keep charging forward like this."

The Demon King of Salvation clicked his tongue and replied, seemingly taken aback by my threat to his life.

—Or so it is.

"Yes?"

—Just charge forward. Close the door when you get close to it.

"Then I'll get killed?"

How could I approach the door when even the Constellations of the highest rank were destroyed by the shockwave?

Then the 'Demon King of Salvation' replied.

—You should be fine now. Ah, it's all done.

Then a message came.

[The effect of the characteristic, 'Record Repairer', is activated!]

[Record repair completed!]

[Exclusive skill, '□□', restoration completed.]

…

[You have become the new 'Recorder of Fear'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 874 Episode 47 King of Fear (18)

Recorder of Fear.

I couldn't quite understand why I was given that role now.

[A huge amount of 'loss' has been collected.]

[The 'loss' you collected will be recorded on the Final Wall.]

As far as I know, I have not yet met the prerequisites to become a 'Recorder of Fear.'

According to the information I heard from Bicheonhori, there are two major conditions to become a 'Recorder of Fear'.

One, you must have reached the 'end' of the world, but were not satisfied with the ending.

Second, you must have the 'possibility of recording' that the Oldest Dream can hope for.

The latter condition was difficult to define, but the former condition was clear.

Both Asmodeus and Bicheonhori survived until the end of their respective world lines, but were not satisfied with the ending, so they became 'Recorders of Fear'.

However, I had not even seen the 'end of the world'. Of course, I did get a glimpse of the ending of the 40th Round through the 'Time Fault', but that was only a glimpse through the 'Time Fault'.

"How did I become a Recorder of Fear?"

Then the Demon King of Salvation answered as if asking why.

—You saw the end of the world.

"The end of the world? Are you talking about what I experienced in the 'Time Fault'?"

—What are you talking about? Hey, here it comes.

I quickly tilted my head back to avoid the shockwave mass flying towards me.

The shockwave mass that passed by my cheek as if it was scratching me crashed into the 'Time Fault Room' and turned the area into dust.

—You're Kim Dokja.

It was dizzying. But strangely, I didn't feel nervous.

As if I had already experienced all of this once, an unprecedented sense of composure settled deep in my heart.

—We already saw the 'End of the World' once in the 1,864th round.

The moment I heard that, something suddenly came to mind.

I looked through the message log and reconfirmed the message I had just seen.

[The effect of the trait, 'Record Repairer', is activated!]

[Record repair is complete!]

The effect of the trait 'Record Repairer' is to restore the 'story' that was lost through the 'Kim Dokja Fragment' that I obtained.

This time, because of the repair, I regained my skill [□□] and became a 'Recorder of Fear'.

"We already had the qualifications of a 'Recorder of Fear'."

—Yes.

"Did Kim Dokja have a story he wanted to change?"

—Maybe.

Even though Kim Dokja saw the end of the world, he still had a 'story he wanted to change'. Neither I, the Demon King of Salvation, nor perhaps the King of Fear know what it was.

Because only Kim Dokja, who was the 'One and Only Kim Dokja', knows.

What he wanted to change could have been the 999th Round, or the 1,864th Round. If not that—

「It could have been right now.」

The shockwave that flew in this time was a large lump. It was an electric shock that I couldn't avoid no matter how fast I moved.

So I didn't dodge. Instead, I opened the [Bookmark] and inserted 'Kyrgios Rodgraim', which I had sufficiently gained understanding of, into the bookmark.

[Exclusive skill, Electrification Lv.???', is activated!]

Kyrgios' exclusive technique, the perfect humanization that reached the realm of the realm, dyed my entire body in the aura of the Baekcheong.

I swung my 'Unbreakable Faith' with all my might toward the lightning wave that was flying towards me.

Tsutsutsutsut!

My fingertips burned brightly as if they had been electrocuted. Sparks began to flow through my entire body along with terrible pain.

It was the price I paid for using power that I couldn't handle at the moment.

—There are several advantages to becoming a Recorder of Fear. One of them is that your tolerance for 'probability' increases.

In fact, Asmodeus, the 'Recorder of Fear', did some ridiculous things, such as interfering with the early scenario, but he was not destroyed by the aftermath of probability.

—In your case, your tolerance would increase even more.

[The story, 'One Who Rewrites Fate', begins its storytelling.]

In addition to the effects of 'Recorder of Fear', the unique effects of the story 'One Who Rewrites Fate' were also added.

As the effects of resisting the aftermath of probability created synergy, the sparks that had been strongly pressing on my entire body began to gradually decrease.

Even though I had called upon the power of 'Kyrgios', I was free from the probability of the <Star Stream>.

"This is not enough."

But it was still not enough to close the door of the Time Fault.

Even so, the Demon King of Salvation was calm.

—It's okay. We've already dealt with the Apocalypse.

"We did."

—The same goes for the Second.

As I slowly blinked, Second child Kim Dokja's story began to be heard through the [Fourth Wall].

He was the 'Watcher of Light and Darkness'.

The experience of the 'Great Battle of the Holy Demons' that he had preserved was being released through me. The story of the Archangels and Demon Kings fighting, and <Kim Dokja’s Company> being active.

[The Giant tale, 'Season of Light and Darkness', tells you.]

The temporarily activated Giant tale took hold of my body.

I started to dash through the lightning waves as if I had a booster.

Tsutsutsut!

I can do it. If I were me now, I could close that 'door'.

—Youngest, left!

I dodged, offset, and pushed back the lightning waves that flew in sporadically, and I slowly advanced toward the door where the final tail was shaking.

[No!]

Jang Hayoung shouted, realizing what I was trying to do.

【The first phase will end soon! The second phase will begin!】

The final dragon's shockwave consists of three phases. If the first phase was 'Lightning', the theme of the second phase was 'Flame'.

And unfortunately, I didn't have a bookmark for a character who could handle 'flames' well.

In other words, the only time I could close that 'door' was while the 'first phase' was still going on.

There was absolutely no time left, and there was no quick solution.

But it was okay.

[You want to do something unexpected.]

[Describe your own actions.]

[Use 5 probability points.]

If there is no method, just write down a method.

[Exclusive skill, '□□', is activated.]

The surrounding scenery began to turn colorless.

[□□, a skill that activates when someone is about to do something unexpected.]

I saved my life several times with this skill at the beginning of the scenarios.

[Warning! The activity of '□□' is not smooth in the area!]

[You have entered the 'Snowfield'.]

[The time to enter the 'Snowfield' is reduced.]

[Describe your next action.]

> # Apocalypse Dragon's Paragraph
>
> 「At that moment, ■■■ is □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□…」
>
> * Based on the current proficiency, a total of ??? additional descriptions are possible.

Is it because I activated the skill after a long time?

Many things were different than before.

My name disappeared, and the total amount of additional descriptions was not written down.

To make matters worse, time was also an issue.

[You can stay in the Snowfield for a total of 20 seconds.]

Only 20 seconds.

I guess the opponent is too strong, so the time you can drag them out is not long.

It was only 20 seconds, but I wasn't particularly nervous or disappointed. Because I could have written a story in those 20 seconds.

I paused for a moment when I was writing my name filled with '■■■'.

Once I started writing the sentence, I picked up speed, and unnecessary sentences and absolutely necessary sentences were quickly sorted out in my head.

[You are currently unable to use the probability you have accumulated.]

Normally, I would have used the accumulated probability to increase the scene reproduction rate, but it was impossible at the moment.

[You lack the probability allowed.]

So I described the sentence without 'additional probability'.

[You lack the probability allowed.]

I checked all the materials and situations, items I could use. Whether it was Constellations, incarnations, or anything else.

[You lack the probability allowed.]

And this was the result.

[You described strange and wonderful content.]

[The reproduction success rate of this description is 50%.]

[Would you like to check the reader feedback?]

I nodded.

I guess I should hear the opinions of our kkoma Kim Dokjas. But I didn't hear the evaluations of the readers. Instead, I heard.

「rlaehrwk37 is saddened by your story.」

「rlaehrwk61 is saddened by your story.」

「rlaehrwk99 is saddened by your story.」

…

I imagined the little readers reading this story in a movie theater, a library, or somewhere in a world I don't know.

[Would you like to try to reproduce it?]

[If you fail to reproduce it, you will die.]

There is only one thing I wish for.

[You succeeded in recreating the scene.]

[You are leaving the 'Snowfield'.]

To make sure that this story I wrote and you read doesn't become meaningless.

「At that moment, Kim Dokja ran.」

I ran with all my might. The magic power of my heart began to beat violently, and the power of the great story flowed over it like a wildfire.

「He was not a complete Kim Dokja.」

I replayed the history of Kim Dokja in my head over and over again. I wondered what they would have done.

「But now he has met the 'Demon King of Salvation' and the 'Watcher of Light and Darkness'.」

So, in order to understand myself, you, and this world better, to endure all this tragedy without resenting it, I read the stories.

[The tale, 'Demon King of Salvation', continues its storytelling.]

[The Giant tale, 'Season of Light and Darkness', continues its storytelling.]

But their tale was too big, too grand, too loud for me to understand. Understanding was far away, like reaching out to a distant star.

That far awayness made me closer to Kim Dokja.

「Even if understanding is nothing more than the light of a star in the middle.」

"Ahhhhhhhh!"

I overcame the shock wave that flew into [Way of the Wind].

「As long as they don't give up understanding, humans can become anything.」

I broke through the shock wave that surged into [Jeon Inhwa].

「Yoo Joonghyuk proved it.」

By borrowing the power of the giant story, I temporarily split the dense lightning waves.

「Again, just like Kim Dokja proved it.」

I ran and ran. My thighs burst and my shoulders were torn, but I didn't care. It didn't hurt.

「That's how he reached the 'Time Fault Gate.'」

I saw a door. A door through which lightning waves were constantly pouring. Now, I just had to close that door.

Kwakwakwakwakwa!

I stepped through the wide-open doorway, canceling out the pouring lightning waves.

And at that moment.

「Kim Dokja thought. 'It's too late'.」

The second phase began.

「The second phase of the apocalypse, 'Flame Wave'.」

Beyond the shadow of the tail that was shaking as if mocking me, the second shock wave of the Final Dragon that would burn everything was coming. The heat was so hot that even the doorknob attached to the 'Time Fault Door' had melted.

「No matter how fast he moved, it couldn't be faster than the 'Flame Wave' starting.」

I saw the red-hot 'Time Fault Door'. The moment I grabbed that door, my hand would melt.

Unfortunately, there was no way for me to handle the 'Heat Wave' right now. It was impossible even if I used a [Bookmark] or activated the story.

I let out a bitter smile. I couldn't close the door by myself.

Unlike Kim Dokja of the 'Great Battle of Good and Evil,' I didn't have <Kim Dokja's Company>.

「No, is there really no one else?」

Somehow, the back of my head felt hot. The heat wave is approaching from the front, and the back of my head feels hot.

I slowly opened my mouth, feeling the subtle heat.

"You managed to avoid getting on the train."

I knew you didn't.

Because I wrote it like that. I used every trick I could to make this guy come to his senses.

"You're a real fucking punk."

I grinned at Yoo Joonghyuk and said.

"I know. Please help me."

"Why should I do that?"

I know you'll help.

Because I wrote it like that.

"That way, the <Star Stream> won't be destroyed."

"I've always lived hoping this place would be destroyed."

I knew you'd say that.

Because I wrote it like that.

"Still, will you help me?"

The heat wave was right in front of me. With the end of a world right before my eyes, I grinned at him.

Then Yoo Joonghyuk said.

"I know your real name."

That wasn’t something I had written.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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My 'real name'.

The moment I heard those words, various emotions surged at once.

Is my brain slightly accustomed to the surging waves of the Apocalypse? Or maybe I just thought that this time I might really die.

I smiled at Yoo Joonghyuk, who was staring blankly at me.

"My name is Kim Dokja."

Yoo Joonghyuk ignored my words and clenched one of his fists. Then, a piece of shining story blossomed in his hand.

"You're the only fool who would put your own name in a dumpling."

"..."

"I'll give it back."

"Thank you for your offer."

I hesitated for a moment and then added.

"I don't think I should take that name back now."

I felt like my resolve would waver if I took that name back again.

If I had insisted on putting my name in a dumpling, there must have been a reason.

Before I knew it, the flame wave had surged up to my nose.

Yoo Joonghyuk took out his Hwangcheon-wolgeuk. Yoo Joonghyuk in the main story used his [Yeolhwasingeom] skill to neutralize the shock wave of the second phase, 'Flame Wave'.

If my guess is correct, Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round would have the same skill.

"[Yeolhwasingeom] is a sword technique. It is not suitable for use as a spear."

"[Yeolhwasingeom] is not used."

At the same time as those words, a magnificent white flame rippled over Yoo Joonghyuk's spear technique.

I opened my eyes wide in surprise.

How could Yoo Joonghyuk use that 'Stigma'?

The next moment, the dazzling light of the 'Stigmata' enveloped my hands as well.

I bit my lips as I looked at the flames of the stigma dazzling on my fingertips.

Not all the sentences I wrote through [□□] are necessarily reproduced in the 'form I have determined'. For example, the sentence I wrote this time was as follows.

「And an unexpected Constellation protected them.」

While writing that sentence, can I really say that I didn't know she would come?

[Stigma, 'Hellfire Lv.???', has been activated!]

[The Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', has declared 'Deus Ex Machina'!]

Deus Ex Machina. An event where the Constellation intervenes in the scenario at the cost of a huge probability.

[The Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', does not want your death.]

I looked up at the sky.

"Uriel."

I spoke to her on behalf of the Demon King of Salvation and the Watcher of Light and Darkness, or on behalf of Kim Dokja.

"I won't die."

My words were true.

Because the ending of this 'Fear Realm' has already been written.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who was ready, spoke.

"30 seconds. That's all I can hold out for."

"That's enough."

"Find a way in there."

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk collided head-on with the flying flames, I started to seriously push the door behind him.

Kkiiyi.

Thanks to Uriel's protection, the door was able to withstand the heat.

But there was a bigger problem.

The door wouldn't close.

Upon closer inspection, the door's hinges were melting and cracking due to the heat wave. If any more time passed, it might become impossible to close the door. There was no time to hesitate.

"Heir-ah."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', grumbles at you not to call it that.]

"Help."

The guy grumbled but also took out the skill I wanted.

[Activate exclusive skill, 'Bookmark'!]

I immediately put a character in the empty bookmark.

[Activate exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???'!]

"I am Lee Hyunsung."

[Exclusive skill 'Incite' corresponds to 'Bookmark'!]

[You can temporarily use one 'stigma' held by the corresponding character!]

Both hands overflowing with brute force.

I started pushing the door again with a lot of strength.

[Exclusive attribute 'Mountain Push Lv.10' is activated!]

I used Lee Hyunsung's exclusive attribute and thought about the scene where he opened the subway door.

「"Whaaaaaaap!"

Lee Hyunsung's biceps swelled as if they were going to burst as he grabbed the door.」

Back then, he opened the door to survive, but now I had to close the door to survive.

Squeak.

The door started to move little by little. However, it was too slow. At this rate, it was impossible to close the door within the 30 seconds Yoo Joonghyuk had said.

Yoo Joonghyuk shouted, his whole body burning like a moth in the heat wave.

"Hurry!"

"I'm doing my best!"

And at that moment.

[It's freaking hot, really.]

The reinforcements I had been waiting for arrived.

「Kim Dokja's fighter was there.」

Jang Hayoung, who had come through the lightning wave, stood next to me and started pushing the door together.

[Eww! My hand! My hand is burning!]

Jang Hayoung originally had no skills related to 'Flames'. However, both of Jang Hayoung's hands were wrapped in bright red strong energy.

「Flame Yang Shingong.」

It seems that she had traded skills through the 'Wall of Impossible Communication' in that short time.

Jang Hayoung was an incarnation that reached a certain level of skill proficiency faster than any other incarnation of the <Star Stream>.

With that level of proficiency, it would be difficult to offset the 'Flame Wave', but it seemed possible to push the door together with me.

[Get up! Harder!]

Jang Hayoung was smiling even as her head was covered in lightning waves and her whole body was accustomed to the flame wave. As if she was enjoying this situation very much.

[Sorry, I finally feel like I can do something.]

As expected, it was a sentence I didn't write. I tried my best, but in the end, I couldn't write. On that blank space, a character who found their own role was smiling brightly.

[Han Sooyoung said. She'll write a lot of my stories in the side story.]

"…"

[How is it? I think I can create pretty cool stories like this, don't you think?]

I looked at Jang Hayoung for a moment and nodded with all my might.

"It's cool."

[Right?]

"But that side story, it might not be written by Han Sooyoung."

[What? Then who’s writing it?]

"That—"

With a kududu sound, the heat wave grew stronger. We stopped talking and focused on closing the door again.

[A little more! A little more!]

When the door was more than half closed, I called Yoo Joonghyuk. Yoo Joonghyuk used [Jujak Shinbo] to quickly evacuate behind us after canceling out one of the waves of the approaching flame wave.

"All right! Close!"

The flame wave flowing in gradually decreased, and finally the door closed.

But.

Kukukukukuku.

Even though the door closed, the flame beyond the portal did not disappear. The passage leading to here was not completely blocked.

Jang Hayoung muttered with a grave expression.

[Damn, the automatic locking mechanism must be broken.]

Even though Jang Hayoung and I were pushing the door with all our might, the door was rattling menacingly.

"Isn't there a way to fix it?"

[There is one, but—]

Jang Hayoung didn't tell me how. I already knew the method that Jang Hayoung didn't tell me.

"That locking mechanism, isn't it on the inside of this 'door'?"

I could see Jang Hayoung flinching. Her expression was like, 'How did you know?'. It was inevitable for me to know.

Because when using the 'Time Fault Door', you always use the 'key' on this side to enter, so the lock must be on the opposite side.

Kim Dokja thought. 'Is this how it's going to turn out?'

The opponent was originally the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse'. This means that even if Yoo Joonghyuk and Jang Hayoung joined forces, it wouldn't be a disaster that could be stopped.

To deal with such a disaster, simply blocking this 'door' would require an enormous probability.

I was in a situation where I couldn't invest in additional probability, so I had to figure out a way to close this 'door' without additional probability.

[No.]

Jang Hayoung grabbed my arm. Very firmly, with a strength that I could never release with my own strength.

[Absolutely not.]

"…"

[This isn't just a 'Time Fault'. Do you know why the other guys can't see this 'door'? Because this is beyond the control of the King of Fear. It’s a completely different world line!]

"Hayoung-ah."

Jang Hayoung’s startled power weakened for a moment.

[Don’t call my name! I absolutely won’t allow it—]

"Jang Hayoung."

Those words weren’t my language. They were the language of the 'King of Fear' that had awakened inside me.

The creaking door was slowly opening again. I could feel the heat wave rushing in.

"This is the only way to close the door."

[I’d rather do it myself—]

"Your [Heat Yang Shingong] won’t be able to withstand the heat wave. And if you go over, there won’t be anyone to manage the Fear Realm."

[Or send Yoo Joonghyuk! If it’s that bastard—]

I shook my head.

"No matter where this is, I’m the only one who has a chance of coming back alive. If it's a 'different world line' like you said, then even more so."

Jang Hayoung, who lowered her head, moved her lips several times. I carefully grabbed her wrist and let her speak. Jang Hayoung couldn't resist.

"Don't worry. Coming back from the dead is my specialty."

The strength she had just used to grip my arm was the last strength she could muster. Having endured the first phase of 'Tail of the Apocalypse' alone, she was already on the verge of exhaustion.

Yoo Joonghyuk took Jang Hayoung's seat as she sank to her feet.

"You can't do it alone."

"I guess so. But you can't help me this time, can you?"

I felt Yoo Joonghyuk flinch. It was natural. Because.

「"Oh, didn't Ryunard say that? That Fault cannot be seen by anyone."」

This 'Time Fault door' is only visible to certain beings.

「"It is a Fault that can only be seen by those like me who came from 'outside' this world, or by the Recorders who watch the worldline."」

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't show it, but he probably couldn't see the 'Time Fault door' right now.

It must have seemed like the shock wave of 'Apocalypse Dragon' was just coming from the air.

That's why Yoo Joonghyuk couldn't close the door like Jang Hayoung.

"Please survive, Yoo Joonghyuk."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded and started to move away with Jang Hayoung.

When they had grown a certain distance apart, Yoo Joonghyuk's voice was heard.

—You must come back to get your name back. It's useless to me.

That was our last greeting.

「At the same time as closing the Time Fault door, the only way I have a chance of surviving.」

I jumped into the gap in the open door. The explosive heat of the flame wave melted my entire body. I rushed forward with momentum.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is activated to the extreme!]

Fortunately, Uriel's [Hellfire] and the function of the [Fourth Wall] protected me.

I immediately closed the door with [Mt. Taesan Push] and pushed the lock from the inside.

「The 'Time Fault Door' was locked.」

The 'Time Fault Door' swirled and disappeared in the empty air.

The problem was this.

[Warning! You are outside the 'World Line'!]

The last dragon's tail was still wagging. To make matters worse, when Uriel's protection disappeared, my body soaked in the heat wave began to disappear.

[The <Star Stream> is watching your strange behavior!]

[Many Constellations are surprised by your choice!]

…

With a tsutsutsu sound, I felt the existing channel being cut off. With the messages rushing into my head, I began to fall down. Suddenly, the number written next to the nameplate came to mind.

「1863-99th Round.」

If that number was correct, I was still in the worldview of the 'Ways of Survival'.

「Worldline of the 1,863rd Round.」

I don't know what the 1,863rd Round of this worldline is like.

The 1,863rd Round is the last time of Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Ways of Survival'.

Perhaps this place was a state where humanity was extinct. Or it could have been a world where Yoo Joonghyuk had already seen the ending and left.

From here on out, it was an unknown space that I had not written.

「All stories flow toward an empty space.」

A moment later, I felt my incarnation body collide with the floor. A terrible pain surged through my entire body as if my bones were broken, and my breathing flowed out through my completely darkened vision.

[Worldline movement was successful.]

A message came into my head.

「I survived.」

A sigh escaped with difficulty.

But I couldn't move a single finger. I didn't feel any sign of anyone. I felt a terrible coldness piercing my heart. I wanted to open my mouth and ask if anyone was there. I had an ominous feeling.

What if it was the world where all the scenarios ended?

What if destruction came, the channels disappeared, and the management bureau and Constellations disappeared?

So if there was no way to return to the original world,

Kuk.

How—

Kuk.

Huh?

Kuk.

I felt someone poking my head. If my guess was not wrong, it felt like a person’s foot.

"What is this?"

A human voice came from somewhere.

"I wondered why the Apocalypse Dragon was acting up again… What are you?"

When I slowly opened my eyes, a faint light penetrated my vision. I saw a white coat fluttering beyond the beam of light.

A coat that looked just like Kim Dokja’s.

「But the one wearing it wasn’t Kim Dokja.」

The cigarette she had in her mouth fell to the floor.

「It’s not lemon candy, it’s a cigarette.」

The moment I saw that cigarette, I realized where I had come to.

"First..."

Swallowing the lump in my throat, I opened my mouth with difficulty.

The '1,863rd Round' that I could come to was already set.

"Nice to meet you."

She was the one who alone saw the end of the 1,863rd Round in the world that Kim Dokja had left.

She lightly stepped on the cigarette that had fallen on the floor and put it out, then looked at me quietly and asked.

"You... look a bit like someone I know?"

That was the first meeting between Han Sooyoung and me in the 1,863rd Round.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 876 Episode 47 King of Fear (20)

First Kim Dokja— The Demon King of Salvation glared at the newspaper on the table with discontented eyes. The kkomas Kim Dokjas who were stuck to his whole body spoke.

「(I can't see it.)」

「(Hyung.)」

「(Show me. Show me.)」

The Demon King of Salvation frowned and pulled off the kkoma Kim Dokjas who were stuck to him one by one. When he pulled off the Kim Dokja who was stuck to his face, he saw the last sentence of the newspaper that was half-torn.

「Successful world line transfer.」

That was the Youngest's last record.

「(What is it? Why did it suddenly cut off? Where did he go?)」

The Demon King of Salvation was inwardly perplexed.

He roughly figured out what had happened. The Youngest jumped into the world line where the Apocalypse Dragon existed to save the others of the Fear Realm, and closed the 'door'. In short, he couldn't control his habit again and committed 'Dokja behavior'.

「(Damn it. Why are all Kim Dokjas like this?)」

He wonders if <Kim Dokja's Company> that used to see him felt like this.

The Demon King of Salvation thought as he stroked the last page of the newspaper where the sentences were cut off.

[The '4th Wall' is currently being restored.]

He had a rough idea of why the sentences were cut off.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall's', composition is extremely unstable.]

The library shook uneasily as if it would collapse at any moment.

A few kkoma Kim Dokjas clung to his legs as if they were scared. Kim Dokja looked around while hanging on to the kkoma Kim Dokjas like a fruit tree.

In the past few days, the [Fourth Wall] had changed quite a bit on the inside. It was already a somewhat dark and gloomy place, but now it had an atmosphere where a real ghost might appear. It wasn't a metaphor, but a real thing, something was wriggling in the darkness inside the library where the light didn't reach.

The Demon King of Salvation knew what that wriggling thing was.

「(Hey.)」

The Demon King of Salvation kicked the thing that was hanging like a larva in the darkness with the tip of his foot. However, the man with a good fortune didn't get up.

When he brought the lamp closer, he could see the man's appearance in detail.

Second Kim Dokja—The 'Watcher of Light and Darkness' was there.

「(How long are you going to sleep? Why aren't you waking up?)」

Of course, he knew that he wasn't simply asleep. The guy wasn't asleep, but rather, he was unable to come to his senses due to serious damage to his stories.

The Demon King of Salvation hesitated for a moment and placed his hand on the forehead of the Second Kim Dokja, who was hanging.

What should I do?

Would it get better if I fed him his favorite 'sad story'?

After a brief moment of thought, the Demon King of Salvation took out the 'sad story' he could think of.

But then, something came crashing down from a corner of the [Fourth Wall]. At the same time, the floor of the library cracked.

The Demon King of Salvation let out a light sigh and stood up, asking the direction from which the sound came.

「(What are you guys doing?)」

At that, the monsters suddenly poked their heads out of the darkness.

The First Kim Dokja pursed his lips and asked.

「(Didn’t I tell you to clean up the fallen books, not to destroy the entire library?)」

At that, the monsters laughed. Their faces were reflected in the flickering lamplight.

They were all Outer Gods that had been in a state of Fear.

From the shell of the 'Dream Eater', to the headless dragon, and…

「(Especially you. Aren’t you doing your job properly? I thought you’d be helpful since you have so many arms.)」

At the Demon King of Salvation’s remark, the four-armed skeleton rattled its jaw. It was the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne'.

「(Just kick them all out?)」

The 'Founder of the Absolute Throne' rattled his skull again with a sullen expression.

The moment the Demon King of Salvation, who was frustrated by that sight, couldn't hold it in any longer and was about to say one more word.

「(Hehe, they can't even speak properly. Don't bother them too much.)」

Three Transcendents appeared with the voice.

Chunghuh, Ryunard, and Karlton.

All of them were key figures of the Transcendent Alliance.

The Demon King of Salvation glared at the three and replied.

「(Then you guys who know how to speak, do it instead.)」

「(Hmm.)」

「(No, why did you crawl here in the first place? You could have just gotten on the train and escaped.)」

「(That's because, unfortunately, we belong to the 'Fear Realm' itself.)」

Unlike the other members of the Transcendent Alliance, the three were cases of being transferred to this world from a 'different worldline'.

The reason they were able to exist in this world was because the 'King of Fear' took on the burden of the lack of probability.

In other words, as the 'King of Fear' who ruled the Fear Realm became affiliated with the [Fourth Wall], their affiliation also changed to the [Fourth Wall].

「(How many more people are trying to come into this already cramped library, damn it.)」

「(…)」

「(If you came in, at least help me out a little. Do you know what our Youngest looks like right now?)」

「(Hmm, I can guess what happened.)」

「(Don’t you have any useful abilities? I’m sure you guys have made a lot of money in your own worlds.)」

「(According to the Transcendent Alliance regulations, we can’t exercise our power outside of the 'Fear Realm'.)」

「(So you’re not going to help us at all?)」

Three people shrugged at those words at the same time.

Chunghuh coughed in vain again and pretended not to know.

「(That Zeus guy is really strong. Are all the 'Myth-grade' guys in this worldline like that?)」

At Chunghuh’s subtle question, something came to mind belatedly. Now that he thinks about it, these three did their part. The reason the Youngest was able to be active in the Fear Realm was because these three held onto the Myth-grade Constellations of the 'Giant Nebula'. If those from other dimensions played that role, it's safe to say that they used most of the probability allowed in this world line.

「(Damn it, stop it. I didn't even expect you to help me in the first place.)」

The Demon King of Salvation approached the table again and began reading the newspaper from the beginning.

So many things have happened at once since he entered the 'Fear Realm'.

The Second Kim Dokja, the King of Fear, is one thing, but...

The incident that particularly caught his attention was the appearance of 'Cheon Inho', who became a Recorder of Fear, and another Kim Dokja.

Those guys are so quiet that it's unsettling.

Even if that's true, the appearance of Kim Dokja, whom the Youngest named 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', was unexpected. The Demon King of Salvation still remembered the figure of the guy who tore his brothers apart.

The one who had been watching this 41st Round before that, the one who had collected over 50 percent of the 'Kim Dokja fragments' and had become closer to the one and only Kim Dokja than anyone else.

Not only did that being start to intervene in the scenario in earnest, but he even appeared in the Snowfield and attacked the 'King of Fear' directly.

This must mean that the probability of this world was slowly flowing to the point where it would allow the guy's actions.

The only good thing was that no more 'Kim Dokja fragments' flowed to him. And thanks to the Youngest, the First and Second who had been separated were reunited.

Now that the two were together, there was only one thing left.

「(Please, take this.)」

The Demon King of Salvation muttered as he pressed the call button on his smartphone.

—Third Kim Dokja.

The guy who always sets his smartphone to 'airplane mode'. In fact, he knew the Third's number, but the Demon King of Salvation had never heard the Third's voice even once.

In fact, he had made a call once. But that time, a strange man answered the phone instead and all he heard was, 'Don't call me again.' At first, he thought he had dialed the wrong number, but no matter how much he thought about it, there was no way that could be true.

Above all, the number of the 'Third Kim Dokja,' was obtained through a deal with the great otherworldly god, 'Bowang.'

[The other party is currently in 'airplane mode'.]

Is it not going to work this time too?

The Demon King of Salvation shook his head and put his smartphone in his bosom.

Just like the First and Second, the Great King of Fear, the Third must also be trapped in his own legend. And within that legend, the Third may have made his own decision.

The Demon King of Salvation let out a light sigh and muttered as he looked at the torn newspaper again.

「(Youngest, I think we'll have to figure it out on our own.)」

But then, the smartphone in his arms vibrated.

—Third Kim Dokja.

The Demon King of Salvation threw down the newspaper he was holding and answered the phone.

Is there really no one there?

Jaehwan let out a light sigh and looked around. The cubic space centered around him, which was exactly ten meters wide, was literally 'blocked' by a translucent membrane.

The dokkaebis of the Management Bureau were more formidable than he thought.

No matter how much he overused his power, he could set up a 'Dark Dimension' that could temporarily seal himself.

'The 《Big Brother》 here must be quite a great guy.'

Jaehwan tapped the translucent membrane. It seemed like it was probably made of a material similar to the 'Void Curtain'.

'I guess I can break through it if I try…'

If you try to break through from the inside, part of this dimension will be blown away.

If you do that, 'that guy' will definitely get angry.

It seems that this curtain can only be opened from the outside...

"That's funny. They say even a tiger will come when you call it."

Jaehwan smirked as he spotted a man approaching from the other side of the translucent curtain.

The man in the pitch-black coat looked around for a moment, then flew straight toward him.

Jaehwan's expression hardened slightly as he confirmed the man who had come close.

"I see you're holding a spear, so it's that guy from 'this worldline'."

The voice couldn't get through the curtain, but the two were still able to understand each other.

The first to speak was Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st Round.

"I need your help."

What had happened on the way here? Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body was almost like rags. The black coat he had been sporting was torn to shreds, one finger was missing from his left hand, and his thigh and shoulder were deeply wounded to the point where the bones were exposed.

Jaehwan said with a bitter smile.

"You look like you need help."

"Will you help me?"

"Are the humans of this dimension incapable of doing anything on their own?"

Yoo Joonghyuk did not respond to Jaehwan's provocation.

Jaehwan glared at Yoo Joonghyuk and then said.

"I can't help you. I'm trapped here because of that damn 'Kim Dokja'."

"I can release you."

"It's not a seal that you can release with just your strength."

As if his pride was hurt by those words, Yoo Joonghyuk tightly shut his lips. Jaehwan added, finding Yoo Joonghyuk's appearance amusing.

"If you want to help me, you'll have to regress a thousand more times. Or bring someone who has regressed that much."

"I can't regress that many times. I don't want to regress any more."

"Since the so-called Regressor has given up on regressing, I guess he's even more useless."

He said that, but Jaehwan's eyes were filled with a strange color.

He liked Yoo Joonghyuk's answer.

"I can save you."

"So, at your current level, this isn't something you can do..."

"Teach me so I can break this curtain."

"What?"

Jaehwan's eyebrows twitched for a moment.

The eyes of the Regressor were endlessly serious.

Jaehwan smiled as he met those eyes.

"You, you saw 'something'."

Jaehwan knew a little about the history of the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.

Unlike him who hated regression, this Regressor lived by repeating thousands of regressions.

He hated to admit it, but this Regressor was quite similar to him.

Just as he repeated 'stabbing' for a long time, this man also became stronger by repeating 'life'.

But that was after the man repeated thousands of regressions.

The Regressor in front of him now was nothing more than a novice who had only regressed a few dozen times.

"You are already close to the peak that you can reach now. It’s not something I can teach you to overcome."

"I know you have a special way to 'transcend'."

Jaehwan remained silent for a moment as if he could accept Yoo Joonghyuk’s sincerity.

"If you use that method to become stronger, you won’t be who you are now."

"But it doesn’t matter."

An expression filled with firm determination.

Jaehwan spoke as if confirming his determination for the last time.

"You’ll think it’s better to die, right?"

It was a warning, but Yoo Joonghyuk looked happy, surprisingly.

"The sea I’ve been hoping for."

Yoo Joonghyuk answered like that and suddenly looked back. There wasn’t really anyone there. Even so, if you were to ask if there was nothing there, that wasn’t the case.

The vast expanse of the <Star Stream> galaxy.

The Constellations that cheered him on, the people he loved. The distant stories he had walked, and perhaps he would have to walk, were there. It was too long a history for one human.

Nevertheless, it wasn’t long enough, so he was still here.

"Because that was the only wish I had made my whole life."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 877 Episode 47 King of Fear (21)

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A lonely wind blew across the Snowfield. Between the lines where the incident disappeared. Above those lines, fragments of stories that were not properly recorded scattered like snow.

「"Kim Dokja, where is he?"」

…

「"Teach me so I can break this curtain."」

…

「"Tell me. Where did Inho-ssi go?"」

The voices of those who were unable to save their precious ones. Words that disappeared without going anywhere.

Listening to those words, he stood on the Snowfield, hung his white coat fluttering in the wind on a chair, sat down at the table, and drank a cup of tea.

「The space given to you was really small, but you have left behind many stories.」

The man read and reread the stories that fell endlessly.

「"Kim Dokja."」

What had once been his name was now a title for someone else. The man was often confused by that fact. He didn't know what kind of feelings he should have.

Should he feel sad, or should he feel liberated?

Or should he feel angry?

As the man made a light gesture, another chair appeared across the table.

The man put down the tea he was drinking on the table and asked.

「Is there anything left to write?」

Another man stood behind him.

A man with bright hair and narrowed eyes. A dark red coat reminiscent of dried blood.

「That's how it is. After writing, you always feel regret.」

「The record of '40th Round' has changed just as you wanted.」

「Well, that's it for now.」

「Then it wouldn't matter if you left.」

Cheon Inho smiled and sat down in the chair the man had prepared. Then he spoke with his characteristic narrowed eyes even narrower.

「Isn't it too rude to treat like that the father you met after a long time?」

「Father.」

The man glared at Cheon Inho with an annoyed expression and added.

「You raised me, right? In this Snowfield.」

「…」

「I often think that way. Maybe the fact that I was raised by a human like you is proof that I'm the 'real Kim Dokja'.」

Cheon Inho nodded and asked.

「Do you still worry about who you are? How many more 'Kim Dokja fragments' do you have to collect before you stop worrying about that?」

「I'll know once I collect them all.」

「Then what should I call you until then?」

「…」

「That friend who uses my incarnation body.」

Cheon Inho grabbed the teacup the man had put down and took a sip of the tea, saying.

「He called you 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja snickered as if he found that title very strange.

「That guy called me Kim Dokja from the beginning.」

「Anyone can see that you are Kim Dokja.」

「No one calls me Kim Dokja except that guy.」

「I'm the one calling you that.」

「…」

「Have you already forgotten that I gave you that name?」

The two looked out at the snowy landscape in silence. Perhaps because there was so much snow falling? Their footsteps were not visible. Nevertheless, the two of them had definitely walked that path where no footprints had been left.

「I still remember the day I picked you up.」

As he said that, Cheon Inho took out a book from his bosom.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

「You were probably born around this point.」

As he said that, Cheon Inho opened the book.

Snowfield Kim Dokja silently read the passage that Cheon Inho had pointed to. The sentences that had begun to look somewhat out of place were written crookedly there.

—The Kim Dokja you know has scattered throughout this universe.

Cheon Inho continued speaking with a strange expression, as if that moment was still vivid.

「You were such a pretty child. It’s hard to believe that such a child fell from the sky.」

「Don’t romanticize it. You just wanted to use me.」

「That’s right.」

Cheon Inho nodded and answered.

「My goal was to feed you the 'Kim Dokja fragments' and revive the 'Oldest Dream'.」

The Oldest Dream.

The absolute observer of this universe that only the 'One and Only Kim Dokja' can become.

「If that was really your goal, why did you betray me?」

「…」

「You raised me, hoping that I would dream your story. But why?」

「I just found an easier way to achieve my goal.」

「Are you satisfied with the records that he changed?」

A subtle edge stood out in Snowfield Kim Dokja’s voice.

「I can discard those records if I become the 'Oldest Dream'. Or I can rewrite them.」

「Of course.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja let out a low breath as if to calm down his anger. Cheon Inho, who was watching him, asked.

「Didn’t you originally like that guy?」

「…」

「Are you angry because he declared that he would become 'Kim Dokja'?」

「…」

「Or because he became friends with the 'Demon King of Salvation' that you hate?」

「Your role was to prevent that guy from living as 'Kim Dokja'.」

「Haha, I made that promise.」

「Why didn’t you keep it? Did you want to see that guy act like the main character in your body? Were you ecstatic to see a new record being written in your incarnation body?」

Cheon Inho nodded.

「It was ecstatic.」

「I could have made you the main character, too.」

「If you were my 'Oldest Dream', it would have been possible. But you know. A wish that came true wouldn’t be very fun, right?」

「Not fun?」

A few snowflakes fell from the sky and fell into the tea. Cheon Inho stirred the tea with a spoon as if trying to find the snowflakes and said.

「Jecheon Daeseong could have ridden the neunda and headed to India at any time. But he walked with Samjang to reach India. That’s how 'Journey to the West' was created.」

「What are you trying to say?」

「It was fun to walk on foot.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja got angry.

「That’s not your story. You’re just a bystander.」

「Still, it was fun. That I can tell that story in my incarnation body. That I can live a life that isn’t one of the 'Ten Evils'.」

「You were incited.」

「That could be possible. However.」

Looking at the tea water swirling around and spinning, Cheon Inho finished his words.

「This world is a huge 'incite' in the first place.」

The two beings looked at the Snowfield again after saying those words. They still couldn't see the footsteps they had walked. However, they no longer thought about the path they had walked.

「So, what are you going to do now? Against your will, he decided to become 'Kim Dokja' himself.」

「...」

「He is not your avatar. He won't listen to you, and he won't move as you dream.」

As he said that, Cheon Inho looked at Kim Dokja's left hand in the Snowfield that had become half transparent. It was a blow to the Fear Realm that had been forcibly used to apply probability.

「He will find an answer that will not destroy this world or not. He is already closer to being the 'main character' than anyone else—」

Cheon Inho asked while looking at the snowflakes piercing through his left hand that had become transparent.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja, how are you going to stop it?」

Snowfield Kim Dokja looked up at the sky and slowly opened his mouth.

「The day I collected more than half of the 'Kim Dokja fragments' with your help, I tore apart my brother who came here from the sky.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja continued to speak.

「I thought I had truly become Kim Dokja. I believed that if I just collected the remaining fragments, I would become complete as Kim Dokja.」

「It sounds like you’re saying no now.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja moved his fingers and wrote someone’s name on the snow piled up on the table.

■■■

A name that was not written.

Cheon Inho asked while looking at the hole.

「It seems I’m not the only one who was incited by his story.」

「…」

「He even threw away his own name to become Kim Dokja. What can you throw away?」

「I’ve thought about it for a long time. What do I really want?」

Snowfield Kim Dokja said as he reached out and wiped the table.

「What do I want to become? Am I satisfied with simply becoming the 'Oldest Dream'?」

「...」

「Can I say that I have become the 'Kim Dokja' I wanted just by collecting all the 'Kim Dokja fragments'?」

Cheon Inho paused for a moment. It was because he sensed an unusual energy from Snowfield Kim Dokja.

「You're right. What's important is not the result, but the process.」

Cracks were slowly forming between the 'Kim Dokja fragments' that made up Snowfield Kim Dokja. A white light was leaking out through the cracks.

「What can I throw away?」

「You, no way...」

Cheon Inho absentmindedly looked down at the book on the table. In the shaking pages, he felt as if he had read this scene in advance.

「Stop. If you do that now—」

「No, this is the right choice.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja was breaking apart.

「From now on, let’s start the real 'scenario'.」

---

Killer King— Cha Sungwoo sat on the rooftop railing of Gwanghwamun and looked up at the sky.

At that moment, the rooftop door opened wide and someone came in.

Cha Sungwoo fixed his gaze on the sky and asked.

"No news today, right?"

"No."

Ye Hyunwoo answered that and walked over to sit next to Cha Sungwoo.

"Maybe it’s time to admit it now."

Half a year had passed since Kim Dokja disappeared from the scenarios. In the meantime, many things had happened to the group.

The Earth was currently in the middle of scenario number 32. In the meantime, the colleagues who had lost their center of gravity split into factions, and some gave up on the scenarios because they died or became victims.

Of course, there were those who didn’t give up, like Cha Sungwoo or Ye Hyunwoo. However, even they had to admit a certain fact now.

「There is no 'Kim Dokja' in this world anymore.」

Over the course of half a year, they had come close to death several times.

As time passed, the face of Kim Dokja in their memories became blurred, and soon became a blank space. Perhaps, both Cha Sungwoo and Ye Hyunwoo knew that it was

time for someone to fill that blank space.

But who on earth could take that role?

"It looks like we're all going to die here."

"Second Apostle, Yoo Joonghyuk doesn't say things like that."

"I'm not Yoo Joonghyuk."

"Did you know that wasn't the case?"

Now, this lonely joke was all that proved their history of living in this world.

"That Yoo Joonghyuk is gone too."

They were left behind in a world where Kim

Dokja and even Yoo Joonghyuk had disappeared. All they could do was copy what they had read.

But even that was becoming increasingly difficult. This was because the scenarios had deviated from the 'novel development' they knew.

"This time, Yerin almost died."

"..."

"Next time, she might really die."

Cha Yerin was critically injured, beyond recovery even with the 'Elaine Forest's Spirit'.

According to Lee Seolhwa, in order to recover from this injury, an item of at least the 'Sung-yu-gwa' level was needed.

"We might have to deal with the Giant Nebulae."

The last option to survive the scenarios.

Ye Hyunwoo also knew that there was such a choice.

"But that..."

Ye Hyunwoo said with a deep sigh.

"What would Kim Dokja do?"

It was then that a meteorite fell from the distant sky.

"Huh?"

The 'Fifth Scenario' featuring the meteorite had already ended. But what on earth is that meteorite?

"2nd Apostle, that is—"

Before Ye Hyunwoo could even finish speaking, Cha Sungwoo jumped down from the rooftop like a man possessed. He then ran straight towards the spot where the meteorite had landed.

Fortunately, the point of impact of the meteorite wasn't too far away.

Cha Sungwoo approached the crater, panting for breath.

A man was lying inside the large crater.

Every cell of his was shivering. The story he had read over a hundred times was telling him who the man in front of him was.

The man slowly opened his eyes and looked at Cha Sungwoo. Cha Sungwoo also looked at him.

He definitely knew who the man in front of him was.

Even so, Cha Sungwoo asked him.

"Who are you?"

The man then asked back.

"Who do you want?"

Cha Sungwoo slowly opened his trembling lips. He wasn't sure whether he should say the name or not. Some ominous premonition was taking hold of him. Just a single name. By saying that name, he had a premonition that the important death of this world would be distorted.

Nevertheless, Cha Sungwoo had to say that name. Because that was.

"Kim Dokja."

It was the wish of all the readers living in this world.

The man slowly opened his mouth after hearing those words with a blank face, whether he knew the expectation or not.

"I am Kim Dokja."

One day, 499 days after the scenarios began on Earth.

"From now on, I will lead the scenarios."

'Kim Dokja' returned to the scenarios.

---

Author's Note

Hello, this is Singsong.

Today, the 4th part of the Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint side story has ended.

Thanks to the readers who joined us, we were able to safely complete the journey of the 4th part of the side story.

We will take some time to prepare for the next season.

The hiatus will be about 2 weeks, from April 3rd to April 17th.

We will come back with a new season on April 18th.

Thank you so much for reading today.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 878 Episode 48 Avatar (1)

Han Sooyoung sat in the office of the penthouse and looked out the window.

The vast view of Gwanghwamun.

After looking at the quiet ruins for a long time, Han Sooyoung suddenly took out her notebook as if she had remembered something and started writing a sentence.

「And so Han Sooyoung was finally facing the Final Scenario of the 1,863rd Round.」

She bit her lip as if she didn't like that sentence at all and added another.

「But can we really call that the 'last'?」

A sentence that seemed like an unnecessary detail.

Was that sentence her own impression of facing the Final Scenario, or was it her regretful thoughts as a writer who had to end the story like this?

Even though the long-awaited moment had arrived, what was this inexplicable feeling of emptiness?

Han Sooyoung hesitated, closed her notebook, took a cigarette out of her bosom, and put it in her mouth.

When she raised her head, the gigantic sphere that filled the sky of the <Star Stream> came into view at a glance.

Seal of the Apocalypse.

As she looked at the sphere that looked like a broken period, it seemed as if the sphere was talking to her.

Asking if she had forgotten something important. Asking if it was too early to end the story here.

[Are you reminiscing?]

When she turned her gaze to where the voice had come from, she saw the wings of an Archangel floating outside the window.

Since the 1,863rd <Eden> had already been destroyed, there was only one 'Archangel' left in this world.

"Jophiel."

The commander of the Red Cosmos—Archangel Jophiel.

[What are you thinking about?]

"Just, various things."

When Han Sooyoung answered, Jophiel also looked up at the sky.

A world where the stars had fallen and only ruins remained.

She had finally come here after going through that hellish scenario.

The Archangel who had witnessed all those years from the closest place spoke.

[You did your best.]

"Yeah, I know."

Han Sooyoung took out a cigarette from her bosom and lit it. Han Sooyoung let out a light sigh as she watched the smoke rising in the air.

"It's just that something feels off."

There were things that came to mind when she looked at the half-broken seal.

Scenario 95.

That day, the pale face that fell from the sky. The short memory of performing the scenario with him. The moment they sat on the rooftop railing and talked together. Fragments of conversation that passed by here and there.

Jophiel asked.

[Are you thinking of 'Kim Dokja'?]

"What nonsense are you talking about?"

[Why are you using 'Poker Face'?]

[Exclusive skill, 'Poker Face LV.???', is activated!]

[Poker Face is a skill used to avoid being caught in front of Lie Detection.]

Han Sooyoung pursed her lips and turned off the skill.

"It's just a habit. Are Archangels originally this interested in other people's business?"

It had already been two years since Kim Dokja had appeared in this world.

The guy who appeared in this world like a comet had messed up this scenario on his own, freed the main character, and even released the Apocalypse before leaving.

「"It's not over just because the Apocalypse was freed. You know that, right?"」

However, thanks to the guy causing such chaos, Han Sooyoung was able to avoid making the wrong choice. She was able to live properly in this world.

[He would have returned to his own worldline.]

"That's right."

The world of Kim Dokja that had disappeared was not this one, and the guy had returned to where he should have been.

Leaving only the author behind in this world where the main character and the reader had left.

Maybe that's why, Han Sooyoung thought quickly. What if she had held onto him a little longer then? Asked him to read her story a little longer.

"He must be eating well and living well there."

If she had told him to watch this world until the end.

[I don’t know about that…]

"No, he’ll forget all about this place and just goof around. That’s just the kind of guy he is."

The time she spent with Kim Dokja was really brief.

Even so, whenever she looked up at the sky like she did now, Han Sooyoung kept thinking of that face that had been smiling subtly.

The man who loved novels more than anyone she knew. Was he still reading 'Ways of Survival'?

Will he remember her- the story of this world?

—Captain, preparations are complete.

When she heard a thought projection from somewhere, she looked down and saw Lee Hyunsung and her colleagues waiting for her at the entrance of the headquarters.

They were the colleagues she had formed after falling here— the 1,863rd Round.

The Delusion Demon Kim Namwoon.

The Maritime Admiral Lee Jihye.

The Beast Lord Shin Yoosung.

The Steel Sword Lee Hyunsung.

The colleagues who had finally reached the limit of their growth potential. The proud characters of this worldline who will not easily kneel down no matter what constellation they face.

Han Sooyoung waved her hand lightly toward them and muttered.

"You all worked hard."

She thought she muttered so quietly that it was inaudible, but Kim Namwoon, who was looking up at her, shouted.

"What are you talking about, Captain! Why are you already making that face that it's all over?"

"There's still the Last Scenario left!"

Han Sooyoung snickered as she listened to Lee Hyunsung's loud voice.

That's right. Their enemies still remained across the sky.

Enemies that were preventing them from passing through the gate of the 'Last Scenario'.

"I'm telling you in advance, kids."

As she said that, she realized that a lot had happened in the meantime.

Now, if she just took one more step, if she just wrote one more sentence, the last phase of this world would end.

But why was it so hard to take that one step, to write that one sentence?

At that moment, Kim Namwoon, who was looking up at her, said something strange.

"Huh? Captain, the movement of the Apocalypse Dragon is a bit strange."

Han Sooyoung raised her head, feeling as if it couldn't be true.

Kugugugu.

The 'Seal of Apocalypse' that was destroyed in the air was causing an abnormal reaction.

Lee Jihye said.

"What, wasn't that kid asleep?"

After the problematic scenario 95 ended, Han Sooyoung used a special method to make the revived Apocalypse Dragon fall 'dormant' again.

But the Apocalypse Dragon that was clearly asleep was moving again.

[No way.]

Even Archangel Jophiel looked flustered.

Han Sooyoung, with a hardened expression, activated [Predictive Plagiarism]. And.

"It's not awake. It's just like a sleepwalker."

[Sleepwalker?]

"It's a bit strange for a sleepwalker, but... What the hell."

The moment she confirmed the tail wriggling inside the sealed sphere, Han Sooyoung shouted at her colleagues.

"Everyone, hide behind cover!"

A shockwave from the Apocalypse soared into the sky with a tremendous air current. An ear-piercing explosion. A dust storm swept over the headquarters. The coughing sounds of the incarnations.

A moment later, when the dust cleared, someone pointed to the sky and said.

"Something's falling over there!"

A star was falling in the distant sky.

---

When I opened my eyes in the darkness, the first thing that hit me was excruciating pain. It felt as if Yoo Joonghyuk had beaten my whole body with [Hundred Steps Godly Fists]. However, since Yoo Joonghyuk couldn't have beaten me, this was probably just the aftereffects of the worldline shift.

「Worldline shift.」

Naturally, past events flowed through my mind like a panorama.

The first thing that came to mind was what happened in the 'Fear Realm'. It was.

「The destruction of the 'Fear Realm' has begun.」

「The time fault where the Apocalypse Dragon was sleeping has opened.」

「To prevent destruction, I personally closed the door to the 'Time Fault'.」

「In the process, I crossed over the door to the 'Time Fault'.」

And this is what happened.

My head was throbbing and I had a headache. There were more than one or two things to check.

「Did the 'King of Fear' safely enter the [Fourth Wall]?」

「What is the possibility of the 'Super-Giant Tale' that I obtained?」

「What power did I gain by becoming a Recorder of Fear?」

「Did Yoo Joonghyuk and Anna Croft safely return to the scenario?」

「Are my party, including Killer King and Ji Eunyu, okay?」

And.

「Where on earth am I right now?」

I had a guess about the last question. It was because the scenery I saw just before I fainted was still vivid in my mind.

However, The problem is.

「My hands and feet won't listen to me.」

At first, I thought it was because of muscle pain. However, as I gradually regained my senses, I realized that wasn't the case.

I couldn't activate [Skills] or [Stigmata].

Right now, I was restrained by a special tool.

「Story Metal.」

The moment I saw my hands and feet tied to the bed, I suddenly got scared.

Where am I?

Why am I tied up?

In the midst of all this, there was a long tube connected to the story vein on the back of my hand, as if it was a consideration to keep me from dying.

"Don't move. The story hasn't stabilized yet."

A pure white woman's face appeared in the darkness. I recognized her at a glance.

"Lee Seolhwa-ssi?"

However, the atmosphere was strangely different from the 'Lee Seolhwa' I knew.

Lee Seolhwa looked down at me with troubled eyes. She seemed to want to say something, but a voice from behind stopped her.

"Okay, just go out."

"Yes, Captain."

As Lee Seolhwa disappeared outside, a deep silence descended on the room. It was not easy to endure the silence while tied up on the bed, so I carefully opened my mouth.

"Excuse me."

Then I felt someone approaching me from the darkness. Under the sound of light footsteps and the soft light, a face I knew well was looking down at me.

「Han Sooyoung.」

The moment I saw her face, my heart ached. Various memories were boiling in my head. Whether or not she knew my feelings, Han Sooyoung opened her mouth in a calm voice.

"You."

"Yes?"

I wondered if my answer was not very good. Han Sooyoung glared at me for a moment and then suddenly asked a strange question.

"You came back?"

"...?"

"Hmm. Judging by your dazzling eyes, isn't it 'that guy'?"

My mind became complicated for a moment.

「This world line was the '1,863rd' of the 'Ways of Survival'.」

And the Han Sooyoung in front of me was definitely 'that Han Sooyoung'.

Han Sooyoung who had received 'half of the memories' from the main body, Han Sooyoung who had come over to the 1,863rd in accordance with the contract with 'Secretive Plotter'.

Han Sooyoung who had tried to seal Yoo Joonghyuk forever in the 1,863rd Round.

"What on earth are you?"

That Han Sooyoung was asking about my identity.

How did I get here, but I had no idea what to say about myself.

I took a deep breath and muttered to myself.

'Constellation-nim.'

In this situation, it would probably be best to borrow Kim Dokja's mouth. Kim Dokja had already met this Han Sooyoung, so he would know what to say in this situation.

He must be there.

But what is it? No matter how long I waited, there was no reply from the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

What is it?

When I looked back, the coat I was wearing had also been taken off. When I turned my head, I saw my coat hanging about ten steps away. However, my hands and feet were tied, so there was no way to check inside the coat pocket.

But.

"Are you looking for this?"

My smartphone was in Han Sooyoung's fingertips.

I opened my mouth without realizing it.

"Please give it back."

Han Sooyoung laughed as if she found me funny.

"Do you know how useless a 'smartphone' is in this world?"

That's definitely true.

Right after the 'scenarios' opened, the 'smartphone' was no longer 'smart'. This is because various skills could sufficiently replace the role of a 'smartphone'.

"Is there something precious in it?"

"That..."

Listening to that vague voice, I thought that maybe Han Sooyoung in front of me already knew a lot.

But even if that was true, I didn't know how to bring it up to her.

「Han Sooyoung of the 1,863rd Round was one of the most important characters in this entire world.」

What if I brought it up wrong and the world line got messed up again?

After thinking about it for a moment, I said,

"There's a novel I like in there."

"What novel? It's not 'Ways of Survival', is it?"

I didn't answer.

Han Sooyoung nodded her head, how she had interpreted my silence was unknown.

"He looks and speaks like that guy, but he's not that guy. But he likes the same novel as that guy... That's interesting."

In that short moment, Han Sooyoung seemed to have finished her insight into the human being called 'me'.

Maybe I had overlooked her. If you think about it, she was the one who knew who Kim Dokja was and where he came from just by reading the 'Sacred Three Questions'.

As I slowly raised my head in a cool mood, Han Sooyoung smiled and opened her mouth.

"You, are you Kim Dokja's [Avatar]?"

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# 879 Episode 48 Avatar (2)

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[Avatar.]

The moment I heard that, my head throbbed.

「"Are you Han Sooyoung's 'avatar'?"」

If I think about it, Kim Dokja, who visited the 1,863rd Round, had also asked Han Sooyoung in front of me a similar question.

Then, her question now might be revenge for that day that had been going on for so long.

I took a deep breath and opened my mouth.

"I."

I tried to say.

I'm not an [Avatar]. Just like you, I'm not just a proxy for 'Kim Dokja'.

But Han Sooyoung nodded without even listening to my answer and began to tell me this story.

"That guy, he's already seen ■■, right?"

"..."

"Well, the flow of time is different in each worldline. It wouldn't be strange if he was faster than me."

What on earth was she thinking when she saw me? Han Sooyoung's face brightened and darkened repeatedly.

"So, why did you come here? Did that guy send you? Was he worried about me?"

"Uh..."

"Or did you come because you were curious about the story of this worldline? Were you curious about the world I created?"

"That's it."

"How's that guy doing? Is he healthy? Does he still make people mad whenever he gets a chance?"

I couldn't bring myself to say that as I watched Han Sooyoung giggle. I couldn't say that the Kim Dokja you remember no longer exists in this universe.

I closed my eyes tightly and answered like this.

"Yes."

But it seems that I was mistaken about Han Sooyoung.

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'.]

My heart went cold. I slowly opened my eyes, and Han Sooyoung was glaring at me with a cold expression.

Her small hand grabbed my collar.

"Hey."

A tremendous amount of blue was flowing out around her. I could sense once again what kind of being Han Sooyoung was in front of me.

She was the only one who had fallen into this Round and reached the end of the world. The 'Director of the False Last Act' who had created an ending that no one could have

imagined.

"Where is that kid now?"

"…"

"Tell me."

Cold sweat was dripping down my back, but I couldn’t answer.

"No."

"Why?"

Because depending on what I said right now, the future of the entire universe could change.

「Han Sooyoung in front of me was going to be 'tIs123'.」

She was the one who had perfected 'Ways of Survival' for the young Kim Dokja.

「She doesn’t yet know that she is destined to be tls123.」

If I had given her false information and the original price had been wrong—if the origin of the modern universe had been distorted—I wasn’t confident that I could take responsibility for it. Of course, no matter what I said, the already-established 'worldline of the beginning' might not change.

But just in case.

"Really? You won't tell me."

Han Sooyoung's eyes turned fierce.

[Character, 'Han Sooyoung', has activated 'Eyes of Truth'!]

「Eyes of Truth became even more powerful than when she met Kim Dokja. Her skill, which had synergy with 'Predictive Plagiarism', began to dissect me.」

"Do you think I can't read it because you're hiding it?"

An alarm bell rang in my head. I realized it instinctively. When that skill starts, all of my stories will be read. Then Han Sooyoung will know everything that happened in the 41st

Round.

「That's dif fi cult」

The next moment, I felt something like the binding of a thick book covering my consciousness.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

Then, a bright spark covered the suite room.

---

To conclude, Han Sooyoung was unable to read the 'story' inside me. This time, it was thanks to the [Fourth Wall].

"Damn, this is the first time I've seen such a vicious guy since that guy. Should I really torture him?"

Lee Seolhwa asked at Han Sooyoung's sharp words.

"Isn't that guy the same guy from back then?"

"That's a pretty philosophical problem."

Han Sooyoung sighed several times and put me back on the bed where I was hanging in the air.

"Hey. Got it. I won't look. Okay?"

Han Sooyoung gave up faster than I thought. Of course, I knew that it wasn't a real give-up. Han Sooyoung is definitely not a soft person. She must have been trying to get information out of me by pretending to persuade me. Han Sooyoung pulled a chair over and turned it upside down toward me, then asked with her arm resting on the back of the chair.

"I really won't see it. I'll make an [Oath of Existence]."

"You can avoid that with [Avatar], right?"

"Oh, you know that too?"

Han Sooyoung took out her notebook as if she had just remembered something and started writing it down. Somehow, the more she talked, the more I felt like she was

stopping me, so I shut my mouth again.

"Are you going to keep your mouth shut?"

"..."

"You must have a purpose for coming to this worldline, too. If you stay silent like that, nothing will change, right?"

Han Sooyoung's urging made me come to my senses once again.

The purpose of coming to this worldline.

That's right. Right now, I wasn't going to just sit around and do nothing.

"How did you end up here? You can tell me that much, right?"

"If you turn off [Lie Detection], I'll tell you."

"Anyway, who would say that bastard's avatar?"

After hearing the message that [Lie Detection] was ending in my head, I slowly opened my mouth.

"I was trying to prevent the destruction of my worldline, and somehow I ended up here."

"The worldline is destroyed?"

I couldn't hide all the information anyway. Since I came to this worldline, I also needed her help.

"To be exact, it almost happened. I managed to stop it somehow."

Han Sooyoung muttered after thinking about something for a moment.

"Is that why our Apocalypse Dragon was talking in his sleep?"

"Sleeping?"

"That's right. So you were trying to prevent destruction and fell into this worldline?"

"Yes."

"That's strange."

"What are you talking about?"

"There's no way that the worldline that bastard is in would suddenly be destroyed. And he's telling his avatar to do this because the worldline is destroyed? The 'Demon King of Salvation' himself?"

For a moment, a premonition flashed through my mind.

A strange smile lingered on Han Sooyoung's lips.

"You're not from the 3rd Round, are you?"

What kind of leap of thought would be required to make such a prediction?

I nodded, hiding my admiration.

"Yes, I'm not from the 3rd Round."

"Then?"

Since I've been caught this far anyway, wouldn't it be okay to at least tell her where I came from?

After making up my mind, I opened my mouth.

"I'm from the 41st Round."

"The 41st Round?"

"I can't tell you more details even if you ask me."

"Why can't I know? Is there any information I shouldn't know?"

Looking at her snickering face, I repeated my resolve several times.

I need to come to my senses.

The opponent is Han Sooyoung, who has [Predictive Plagiarism].

If I spill strange information, I'll ruin the whole story.

"There's a lot."

"I'm even more curious when you say it like that."

"Even if you're curious, I can't tell you."

"As far as I know, there were two '41st Round' in 'Ways of Survival'."

Even if it was Han Sooyoung, I didn't know that she could recall that much just by hearing the words '41st Round.'

"Once, the 41st Round before Shin Yoosung returned to the past. And once, the 41st Round after Shin Yoosung returned to the past."

I deliberately kept my mouth shut.

But Han Sooyoung seemed to have read something from my silence.

"Judging by your expression, you're from the former. Right?"

How could Kim Dokja dare to have a 'Sacred Three Questions' with Han Sooyoung, who would bite at the end of every word and chase after the truth?

I nodded and answered.

"Yes. That's right.

"Wow, you really came from the worst Round. There, Yoo Joonghyuk is a total idiot, right?"

"That's right."

As expected, Han Sooyoung also seems to know about the infamy of the 41st Round.

"Actually, it's not that much of a idiot."

"Huh? Are you protecting Yoo Joonghyuk right now?"

"Not to the point of protecting him, though."

"Anyway, you're similar to him in that you talk back to me every time."

Han Sooyoung looked quite pleased for someone who said that.

"Anyway, then you're pretty lucky, aren't you?"

"Yes?"

"You escaped that horrible '41st Round'. You seem to have enough memories to survive even if you're separated from your main body."

I'd never thought of it that way.

"What do you say, just stay here. Living in another world would be a pretty refreshing experience, right? Anyway, if you go back, you'll be integrated into the main body."

The person who said that was the one who actually did it herself.

Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round was an avatar who had received half of the memories from the main body. No, at the point where half had been transferred, it would be difficult to determine which side was the 'main body'... Anyway.

"So, who did you make a contract with to come over?"

"A contract?"

"If you had attempted to move between worldlines, wouldn't you have made an 'Outer World Convent'?"

As I blankly looked up at her face, something suddenly occurred to me.

「<Star Stream>'s 'worldline movement requires special probability.」

Originally, in the <Star Stream>, 'worldline movement' was only possible under special conditions.

For example, based on the main story, there were three ways to 'move worldlines'.

One was to use Yoo Joonghyuk's 'regression'.

In the main story, <Kim Dokja Company> realized that the essence of 'regression' was to create a 'new worldline' and there was a time when they practiced 'collective regression'.

The second was when they attempted to move to another worldline using the 'Last Ark' used by the saints.

As expected, this was the method used by <Kim Dokja Company> and Yoo Joonghyuk in the main story, and they boarded this ark and returned to their original round in the 1,865th round.

The last, third was to make an 'Otherworldly Covenant'.

The Han Sooyoung in front of me was the case of crossing the 'worldline' using that third method. The Outer God she contracted with was 'Secretive Plotter'.

"Huh? Who did you contract with?"

In her eyes, I had neither [regression] nor come over on the ark. So it was natural to assume that I had crossed the 'worldline' through the third method.

"That's... I..."

And that was exactly the problem.

「I did not make a 'Otherworldly Covenant' with anyone.」

I had simply come over here through the door of the 'Time Fault'.

The moment I realized that fact, I felt a chill.

I heard this.

「Is that even possible?」

Even that great Secretive Plotter had to expend a considerable amount of probability to help Kim Dokja move through worldlines. But now I—

Tsutsutsutsut.

Sparks lightly flew around my incarnation body. My breathing became faster little by little. Even though the [Fourth Wall] was clearly activated, it was difficult to move my incarnation body. It was clear why.

Right now, the 1863rd Round was unable to accept my existence.

[The <Star Stream>'s probability is moving!]

[The Management Bureau has noticed your presence!]

[The Dokkaebis of the Management Bureau are questioning your existence!]

A sign of the aftermath slowly creeping in.

I opened my mouth urgently as I listened to the ominous message blaring in real time.

"I, absolutely must survive. I must return alive."

"What?"

How did I get here, I couldn’t die because of the probability.

"Please help me."

If it was Han Sooyoung, there must be a way. If she had [Predictive Plagiarism], there must be a way to overcome my current situation. But.

"Why me?"

"Huh?"

Han Sooyoung asked back in a cold voice.

"You, you didn’t come over to see me?"

The moment I heard that, I realized the identity of the strange sense of discomfort I had felt throughout the conversation.

"That bastard, he forgot all about this side, didn’t he?"

That’s right.

Perhaps <Kim Dokja Company> wasn’t the only one to lose 'Dokja'.

After Kim Dokja left, Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round.

"Why should I help the avatar of a guy who doesn’t even care about what happens to this world?"

She was completely upset.

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# 880 Episode 48 Avatar (3)

"No, wait a minute."

It was unfair. Because it wasn’t me who left Han Sooyoung alone for the 1,863rd Round.

"I’m not an [Avatar]."

"Then what?"

"I—"

I hesitated. I couldn’t think of anything I could say to persuade her.

For a moment, a brief temptation occurred to me.

What if I just used [Incite]? If I used [Incite] to persuade Han Sooyoung to do my bidding.

"I can hear your head spinning."

The moment I heard Han Sooyoung’s laughter, I realized. The opponent in front of me wasn’t someone who could do that.

There was nothing I could do. From here on out, I had no choice but to play fair.

"Just as you're not the avatar of 'Han Sooyoung in the 3rd Round', I'm not just Kim Dokja's avatar."

Han Sooyoung smiled as if she found it interesting.

"Really? How much of your memories did you inherit?"

"I barely received any memories."

"Yeah. They call someone like you [Avatar]. But isn't that right?"

"Does the amount of memories you have matter? It's not the amount of memories that proves who I am."

"Is that so?"

Han Sooyoung nodded and wrote something in her notebook.

I added while looking at Han Sooyoung like that.

"Just because Han Sooyoung did something wrong in the 3rd Round, you wouldn't blame her for it. It's a bit unfair to blame me for Kim Dokja's mistakes."

"Are you trying to say that you're not that Kim Dokja?"

"Yes. I'm not the Kim Dokja you know."

"Then there's no reason for me to help you? Because you're not that Kim Dokja."

Is that really the case? Damn it. I quickly changed my subject.

"But there's something called joint responsibility in this world. Since I'm also using Kim Dokja's name, I think I'm qualified to atone for his mistakes."

Kim Dokja's joint responsibility.

It feels a bit unfair. If there is a responsibility for the Kim Dokja Solidarity, shouldn't there also be benefits for the Kim Dokja Solidarity? But I've never received anything like that.

Of course, I couldn't complain to Han Sooyoung right in front of me.

Han Sooyoung stared at me blankly and chuckled.

"How are you going to atone for this?"

I cleared my throat slightly and began to speak.

"It’s all my fault. I’m sorry for leaving you alone. But I didn’t do it on purpose either."

Han Sooyoung’s eyes shook subtly. I didn’t miss that moment and continued to speak.

"I was curious about your story too. I was curious about how you were doing, what you were thinking, and if something big had happened in your world."

"…"

"I didn’t intentionally avoid visiting. I was just scared."

"Are you scared?"

"Sometimes, when it’s a story you really like, it’s scary to know the ending."

Han Sooyoung quietly watched me like that, then glanced at Lee Seolhwa who was peeking at her from behind and smiled bitterly.

"If someone saw me, they'd think I was doing this because I wanted an apology."

"You weren't?"

"What would I do accepting something like that?"

"Then why are you upset?"

Was that too direct? Han Sooyoung's expression cracked for a moment.

I didn't miss the opportunity and asked.

"Do you by any chance like Kim Dokja?"

"What?"

"If that's not the case, there's no reason for you to be so upset. Weren't you and Kim Dokja just in a business relationship? You gave and took. You broke up cleanly."

"…"

"Or did you actually want to go back to the 3rd Round with Kim Dokja?"

Han Sooyoung belatedly asked with narrowed eyes.

"You're talking about having a pierced mouth, but have you forgotten who's holding the knife?"

"I know. You're holding on to it. And very tightly. So please spare me."

"Oh my."

"If you spare me, I'll help you meet Kim Dokja."

Han Sooyoung paused for a moment and asked back.

"Why do you think I want to meet that kid?"

"If not, I'm sorry, but that kid would really want to see you."

Han Sooyoung's expression once again showed embarrassment.

"If you keep talking nonsense…"

"Han Sooyoung."

Tsk tsk, sparks colored my incarnation body along with the sound. I decided to settle the matter before the aftermath grew any bigger.

"Kim Dokja is in danger. Only you can save him."

Kim Dokja is in danger. I clearly saw the blue that spread across Han Sooyoung's expression at those words. I was a little envious, and a little sorry.

"Can you take responsibility for that statement?"

"Yes, I can take responsibility."

I knew how cowardly my words were.

Even if I didn't do anything, she would meet Kim Dokja again. More precisely, the less I did anything, the higher the probability that she would meet Kim Dokja again.

She was destined to become tIs123, and she would definitely meet the young Kim Dokja.

Of course, it wouldn't be the kind of reunion she wanted.

"How is Kim Dokja in danger?"

"That is…"

"If I save you, you will tell me?"

When I nodded, Han Sooyoung glared at me with a disapproving look and asked.

"I need to know who you made a contract with to come here."

"Will you help me?"

"I will listen to your story."

Fortunately, the atmosphere was not bad. I swallowed a light sigh and said.

"I didn’t make a contract with anyone."

"What?"

"I didn’t make an 'Otherworldly Covenant' to come here."

There is a possibility that an 'Otherworldly Covenant' that I don't know about has been activated.

Strictly speaking, I came here through the 'Fear Realm', and the owner of the 'Fear Realm' was the 'King of Fear'.

The 'King of Fear' held numerous Outer Gods, so it would be safe to say that the 'Fear Realm' itself was an 'Otherworldly Covenant'.

However, the 'Fear Realm' has now been destroyed, and the 'King of Fear' has lost his power.

In other words, the 'contract' that sent me here has lost its effect. However, Han Sooyoung's expression upon hearing my words was strange.

"Wait a minute, then you—"

At that moment, thunder rang out from outside the window. Han Sooyoung's eyebrows furrowed and Lee Seolhwa opened the curtains by the window almost at the same time.

"Captain, something is strange!"

Lee Hyunsung's shout from outside. There was a huge portal swirling in the sky outside the window.

I and Han Sooyoung knew what it was.

「Great Hall.」

A passageway to another world was about to open in the vast expanse of sky. A tremendous feast could be felt beyond the hall.

Han Sooyoung glared at me with a frown.

"What on earth have you done?"

I looked up at the sky in confusion.

「Even if it was the 1,863rd Round, there's no way a 'God of Another World' would suddenly descend in the clear sky.」

The scale of probability eventually shifted toward offsetting its weight.

If a God of Another World had appeared, it meant that there was a 'probability' that he would descend in this world line.

My heart sank.

「It's because of me.」

Up until now, my existence had been protected by a 'scenario'.

[The Management Bureau does not accept your existence.]

However, there was no scenario assigned to me in this worldline. In other words, the current me was an existence that was not needed in the 'scenario'.

Tsutsutsutsut!

The spark that was immediately felt in my incarnation body was the proof.

This worldline does not consider my existence 'probable'. Therefore, in order to protect the probability of this world, my existence must disappear.

【Ooooooooooo.】

Therefore, the guy coming over from the 'Great Hall' right now was a kind of grim reaper that came to erase me from this world.

【IwantitIwantitIwantitI

"The Final Scenario is right around the corner, and because of this kid, the Earth could be destroyed."

I nodded calmly and said.

"I'm really sorry. So please help me, Han Sooyoung."

Han Sooyoung grumbled as if she was dumbfounded by my words.

"This is really shameless."

"You don't have a choice anyway. If you don't help me, your worldline will be destroyed."

"What do you want me to help you with?"

"Please help me return to the 41st Round."

As I said before, there are several conditions needed to 'move worldlines' in this world. However, I wasn't Yoo Joonghyuk, and I didn't have an 'ark' to cross worldlines like the Constellations.

So now, the only thing left for me is the last method.

"I will make an Otherworldly Covenant."

"Will that work now?"

"Why not?"

"With that kind of thing targeting you right now, do you think there would be an Outer God that wants to make an 'Otherwordly Covenant' with you?"

Han Sooyoung was right.

The otherworldly deity that is making an 'Otherworldly Covenant' right now will definitely clash with the Outer God targeting me from beyond the 'Great Hall'.

In other words, only a being stronger than the 'Outer God' targeting me would accept my offer.

"If the guy over there is stronger than the 'Old Being', then there is a possibility that he is at the level of the 'Great Old Being'."

Great Old Being.

I kept my mouth shut at that expression that I had finally heard. Han Sooyoung added, how she had taken my silence unknown.

"If the guy over there is at the 'Great Old Being' level, then there will be no Outer God that will help you."

I knew it too.

The Outer God that reaches the 'Great Old Being' level is a kind of 'Mythical Constellation' among the Outer Gods.

Still, I shook my head.

"No, it's not like there's no one."

Even if the being that covets me from beyond is a 'Great Old Being', it's not like there's no Outer God that can stand against it.

"You, really."

Han Sooyoung's expression as she looked at me was strangely hardened. Perhaps she had realized it too.

"The being that brought you to this 'worldline'."

The only being that can stand against a 'Great Old Being' is a 'Great Old Being'.

I took a deep breath and opened my mouth.

"Han Sooyoung, please call 'Secretive Plotter'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 881 Episode 48 Avatar (4)

Secretive Plotter.

I had no intention of receiving his help until now. It was questionable whether he would respond in the first place, and I was afraid that my call would cause even greater chaos in the universe.

However, that was when I was in the 41st Round.

This was the 1,863rd world line, where there was already a 'contractor' who was clearly connected to him.

"Are you in your right mind? Do you even know what you're talking about?"

"This is an extremely corrupted god."

'Secretive Plotter' was the strongest deity I knew. One of the 'Great Old Beings', and the King of the Outer Gods called 'Great Plotter'.

If I could only receive his help, if I could somehow make a deal with him, then it would be possible to resolve this situation.

【Gugugugugugu.】

A loud noise rang out in the sky once again. The Outer God who was trying to interfere with the 1,863rd world line was moving. The scenario was nearing its end, and the 'Void Curtain' covering the Earth would have become extremely thin due to the possibility of my appearance. If things continued like this, it was only a matter of time before the 1,863rd Round would collapse.

Han Sooyoung, who was frowning, shook her head and said.

"No. I can't call that guy. My contract with that guy is already over."

The contract is over?

"Didn't you hear anything from the main body? The moment Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,863rd Round made that choice, my contract ended as well."

I thought deeply about the contents of the main story.

「"I made a contract with 'Secretive Plotter' for the completion of 'a certain world'. If he gave me what I wanted, I agreed to help him complete the world he wanted."」

In the main story, Han Sooyoung of the 1,863rd Round clearly said that. The 'world' she spoke of must have been this 1,863rd world.

Separated from the 'main body', she wanted to have her own world, and Secretive Plotter provided this 1,863rd Round's world as her stage, and in return, Han Sooyoung promised 'Yoo Joonghyuk's death'.

"Yoo Joonghyuk chose both regression and death."

And thanks to Kim Dokja's great performance, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,863rd Round split into two, one choosing 'death' and the other choosing 'regression'.

Because Yoo Joonghyuk succeeded in 'death', the 'Otherworldly Covenant' that Han Sooyoung made was also completed.

"I can't contact the Secretive Plotter anymore. I don't even know where he is or what he's doing."

"Have you ever called him?"

"I've asked for help a few times. But that was already two years ago. Now, the line that could contact him has disappeared."

My heart sank.

In the sky, a tremendous Outer God comparable to a 'Great Old One' was about to come over, and Secretive Plotter couldn't be contacted.

"Even if I could contact him, it's a problem. Have you forgotten that every 'Otherworldly Covenant' comes with a price?"

"I can handle whatever the price is."

"Even if you can handle it, it's difficult for us. We don't know what the 'Gods of the Other World' want."

Han Sooyoung's words were understandable.

She was now facing the 'Final Scenario', and she had probably prepared all the plans through [Predictive Plagiarism].

But if a guy suddenly fell from the sky and called the 'Gods of the Other World', it was bound to be difficult.

But this side couldn't just give in.

"If I want to return to my original worldline, there's no other way than to get help from the 'Gods of the Other World'. If you delay any longer, your world will truly be destroyed."

Anyway, if I couldn’t return to my original worldline, this world was over.

However, Han Sooyoung seemed to have a different opinion than me.

"Well. There’s an easier way than you going home."

I didn’t ask what it was. I knew it without asking.

Lee Seolhwa, whose face turned pale, grabbed Han Sooyoung’s shoulder.

"Sooyoung-ssi. No."

"Let go."

"He’s innocent."

"He’s already committed a serious crime by bringing that kind of thing into our world."

A cold murderous aura rose from Han Sooyoung's body as she looked at me.

"And this kid, no matter how I look at him, he looks a little dirty. He suddenly fell from the sky and threatened me with Kim Dokja, saying that he was in danger."

"…"

"It's also strange that he came from the 41st Round. Why did he come from the 41st Round and not the 3rd Round? Did Kim Dokja split like slime and scatter all over the universe?"

She was diagnosing the situation so accurately that I was speechless for a moment.

Han Sooyoung spoke in a cold voice as if to cut off the remaining chain of emotions.

"It's better to just kill him here. That 'God of the Other World' came after this guy anyway."

"Just wait. If you kill me—"

"Why, do you have any memories that shouldn't be lost? Don't worry."

Han Sooyoung smiled brightly and said.

"I'll retrieve your memories and return them to you."

I never thought that Han Sooyoung of the 1,863rd Round would be this fast.

She had activated [Predictive Plagiarism] and made her judgment. Eliminating me here was the safest way to protect the world she had protected.

"Even if you have Kim Dokja's memories, you can't trade it for the destruction of this worldline?"

Listening to her calm and composed voice, I felt like I understood her feelings a little.

"Is that so?"

When I write, such moments come. No matter how much I cherish the character, there are times when I have to sacrifice them in order to protect the world's probability—or to keep the entire story from being ruined.

Perhaps Han Sooyoung decided to take responsibility for it by killing me.

I smiled as I watched the [Black Flame] burning in her right hand.

"I respect your choice."

"Yes, thank you."

Han Sooyoung’s hand rose into the air like a guillotine blade.

The moment her hand, which must have written and erased countless sentences, was about to strike my neck, I opened my mouth.

"But do you know that?"

I certainly understood her as a writer. However, I was not a writer in this world right now, but a 'living figure'. So,

"The 'Oldest Dream' is not a 'giant baby'."

I should struggle to survive as a character.

Han Sooyoung paused and glared at me. Looking at her hand that had stopped exactly three feet in front of me, I calmly continued speaking.

"You must have guessed it too. What kind of structure does this world have? How are the worldlines connected? Why do the stories always flow to 'empty places'?"

"You seem to be trying to pique my interest by telling a plausible story—"

"That's right. So while I'm at it, let me say one more thing."

One day, the King said,

"Everything is already written, and it's being written at the same time."

If all of this is inevitable, and it's already written and being written at the same time—

"Han Sooyoung, do you think it's just a coincidence that I came to this world?"

A puzzle was fitting together in my head.

1,863rd Round, Han Sooyoung's future and how she saw the 'end of the world'. And even her clearing process that wasn't written in the main story.

"If you kill me, you'll never see the end of this world."

The moment I looked into Han Sooyoung's eyes, I was certain. Right now, she was thinking the same thing as me.

"How... do you know that?"

If she has [Predictive Plagiarism], if she will use 'Ways of Survival' in the future, she must have already guessed.

How this world is structured, and what is the 'wall' she will encounter at the end of this 1,863rd Round.

What she needs to overcome that 'wall'.

"In order to see the end of the world, you need the 'Fragments of the Final Wall'."

"If it's a fragment, I have it too."

"But you couldn't get the 'Final Fragment'."

Han Sooyoung's eyes widened.

"Because that 'Fragment' doesn't exist in this worldline."

The last fragment of the Final Wall, only Kim Dokja has it.

Because this world exists to save Kim Dokja, who is the 'Oldest Dream'.

That's why Yoo Joonghyuk of the 'Ways of Survival' couldn't reach his own fire even after reaching ■■ of the world.

"I can help you get over the 'Final Wall'."

Han Sooyoung’s lips parted.

Even without using [Lie Detection], the current Han Sooyoung would have known that what I was saying was true.

A loud noise rose from the sky again.

Han Sooyoung opened her mouth.

"I can’t call upon a deity of the other world."

My mouth watered without me knowing. Could it be that you're planning to kill me even after saying this?

Thankfully, I didn't feel the same murderous intent from Han Sooyoung as before.

"I'm saying that there's no need to use such dangerous methods to send you back to your original worldline."

"That means—"

"No matter how you go, you can just go to Seoul, right?"

However, there's no way for the current me to cross through worldlines without making the 'Otherworldly Covenant'.

No, if there was a way…

"Is there still an 'ark' left in this worldline?"

Han Sooyoung pointed outside the window. Higher than where the seal of the Apocalypse Dragon was located. At the edge of that sky, the stern of a ship was visible, sticking out as if it was stuck in the sky.

"That is..."

"It's the ark that the guys who were trying to escape to another world were on. If we retrieve it and fix it, it should be usable."

"Ah."

"Originally, I was just going to blow it up. That 'ark' was blocking the gateway to the Final Scenario."

In other words, Han Sooyoung was going to retrieve that ark for me.

However, there was one problem that both Han Sooyoung and I knew about.

Kudduddud!

I heard the sky splitting and the sound of the curtain tearing. The color of the sky seemed to change, and then the 'True Word Defense System' that was protecting the headquarters area began to collapse.

Finally, the Outer God beyond the curtain was coming to this worldline.

"Han Sooyoung."

I called her urgently.

I couldn't retrieve the ark right away. If I don’t stop that Outer God right now, this worldline will be over before I can do anything right.

"He’s the one who came after me, so I’ll buy some time."

"…"

"Even if he catches me, I won’t die right away. If you retrieve the ark while I’m buying some time—"

"What are you talking nonsense?"

"Huh?"

The moment I saw her expression, I realized something.

This worldline was in its 1,863rd Round. And Han Sooyoung was the 'Constellation' facing the 'Final Scenario' of this world.

[The Constellation, 'Director of the False Ending', is looking at you.]

Only then did I realize her status, the power of the tales she had built up.

I could feel it.

"Me and my colleagues didn't just go through the scenarios carelessly."

A dazzling light flowed out from Han Sooyoung's entire body.

"It was originally meant to be used to blow up the ark, but there's nothing I can do about it."

The story she had endured and lived through was talking about it.

[The Giant Tale, 'Han Sooyoung Corporation', begins its storytelling.]

The story soared into the air, leaving behind a beautiful tail.

However, no matter what kind of history she had accumulated, the opponent was an Outer God that surpassed the 'Old Being'.

Even if the Myth-grade Constellations joined forces, it was a difficult enemy to deal with.

No matter what this worldline used, it was impossible to defeat that 'Outer God'.

"Great Nebula Destruction Weapon unleashed."

Great Nebula Destruction Weapon?

I hurriedly looked up at the direction Han Sooyoung's story had been sucked into.

「There was one. Just one. A being that can stand against that 'Otherworldly God'.」

But I thought that was impossible. No matter how strong Han Sooyoung was, there was no way she could control such a disaster.

「But Han Sooyoung did it.」

The 'Sealing Orb of the Apocalypse' that had absorbed Han Sooyoung's tale began to emit blue light. Watching that sight, I finally realized how Han Sooyoung had defeated those terrifying Constellations and Demon Kings and reached the end of this world.

"Adjust the Apocalypse's sleep phase to REM-3."

She had succeeded in turning that 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse' into a weapon.

The Apocalypse, whose eyes were still closed, raised its head toward the sky as if it was annoyed. And then in the next moment.

"Get rid of it."

The Apocalypse's breath breathed ecstatic fire toward the atmosphere where the Otherworldly God was coming from.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 882 Episode 48 Avatar (5)

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If you think about it, there’s a reason why dragons are so strong in the <Star Stream>. They’ve been objects of fear and awe since time immemorial.

Everyone has heard stories of wizards or knights fighting dragons at least once.

I was like that too. I loved dragons so much that I even read the pages of the 「Encyclopedia of Fantasy Beasts」 that had 'dragons' in them over and over again.

I imagined what it would be like if I could tame a dragon—or if I could fly on one.

But while I was just imagining, there was someone who made that imagination a reality.

Kuooooooooo!

Along with the feeling of the air being compressed, the dragon’s breath, filled with splendid tales, pierced the sky.

「Breath of the Apocalypse.」

The original 'Last Dragon of the Apocalypse''s main skill was its 'tail wagging', but the Apocalypse didn’t always just wag its tail. Like any other dragon, the Apocalypse also uses its breath. Especially when dealing with a powerful 'single entity' like this.

【Ooooooooooooooo—!】

The breath went straight through the atmosphere and struck the Outer God beyond the curtain.

A long and painful cry was heard from beyond the curtain.

As expected, even an Outer God beyond the 'Old Being' level would not be able to handle the power of the Apocalypse Dragon.

The fiercely swirling 'Great Hall' was slowly closing.

I was dumbfounded by that unbelievable sight and just looked up at the sky.

Who would have thought?

That it would be possible to make that 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse' into a weapon.

That's when I heard an angry voice from afar.

【Unauthorized... You will be punished.】

I came to my senses for a moment.

That's right. Even if it was the Final Scenario, there was no way such incredible power could be possible without a price.

In fact, a different pattern appeared in Han Sooyoung's eyes as she reached out toward the sky. It was a pattern I knew.

「Ring of Chaos.」

A similar pattern had appeared in the eyes of Jung Heewon, who had defeated the Demon Kings in the 'Seongma Daejeon'.

"Han Sooyoung?"

At that moment, I felt like I understood many things.

I understood why she had said she could not call 'Secretive Plotter' and why she had been reluctant to make a new covenant with a 'Divine Being of the Other World'.

She had already made a new 'Otherworldly Covenant'.

And with a 'Divine Being of the Other World' that was powerful enough to defeat that 'Old Being'.

Tsutsutsutsu.

At that moment, an ominous spark began to fly from her entire body.

"Han Sooyoung!"

The moment I suddenly stood up from my seat, sensing the ominousness, the scenery of the world stopped.

[Exclusive skill, '□□', is activated!]

The scenery was dyed colorless.

[Entering 'Snowfield'.]

[There is a lack of probability for 'Snowfield' to continue.]

['Snowfield' does not function smoothly in this area.]

['Snowfield' will end soon.]

If 'Snowfield' was activated regardless of my will, there is only one reason.

A decisive event in this 'worldline' is about to happen right before my eyes.

I immediately looked up at the sky and saw a pitch-black lightning bolt flowing out of the 'Great Hall' just before it closed.

It was clear who the lightning bolt was targeting. Han Sooyoung opened her eyes wide. I had no time to think or write a sentence.

['Snowfield' ends.]

I almost instinctively flew toward Han Sooyoung.

Following that, a massive torrent poured down from the sky, piercing through the outer wall of the base and exploding into the room. Darkness fell upon the world.

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In the strange darkness, I could hear mutterings.

"This guy is that guy's avatar?"

"The stories said so."

"That's why he faints in a similar way."

…

"Get out of the way, I need to give him medicine."

"Medicine?"

"It's a new medicine made by stories."

"Oh, what is it? It's so luxurious.

"They say it tastes like lemon candy."

"Can I have one too?"

"Kim Namwoon, do you really want to lose?"

…

"This kid doesn't get up easily. Is his injury serious?"

"He got hit directly by the Chaos Wave."

"What's a direct hit? It must've just grazed."

"Even if it grazed, it's enough power to annihilate a mediocre Constellation."

"How did this guy endure that?"

"I don't know. Anyway, the Captain survived thanks to this ahjussi."

"Damn, I should have been next to the Captain!"

I tried to catch my breath and roll over several times. After about an hour or two, I gradually regained my senses.

[The story, 'One Who Rewrites Fate', continues its storytelling.]

[The exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is activated.]

I slowly opened my eyes, and the first thing I saw was Lee Jihye's pale face.

"Oh, his eyes are open."

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The one who supported me, who still couldn't move my hands and feet, and put me in the wheelchair was Kim Namwoon.

"Hey, just lie down."

Kim Namwoon put me in the wheelchair with a look that seemed to be annoyed, and he roughly fixed my hair.

"Good, now you look like a person."

I saw myself in the mirror with the same hair as Kim Namwoon. Kim Namwoon asked with a satisfied smile.

"Can you speak?"

I moved my neck and nodded. Although the base of my tongue was a bit numb, I was able to communicate.

What on earth happened?

The next thing that came to mind was the memory of the pitch-black lightning that broke through the outer wall of the building and flew in.

I instinctively looked out the window. The weather was surprisingly clear. I couldn’t even see the swirling 'Great Hall'.

Did the Outer God retreat?

Perhaps the lightning that was shot at us was the Outer God’s last struggle.

Then did Han Sooyoung succeed?

Kim Namwoon, who was watching me, waved his hand in front of my eyes and added.

"Are you crazy, sir? It’s been two days since you woke up. I’m in charge today, so if you need anything, just ask me."

"…"

"You took the medicine that Seolhwa-noona gave you, so you should be fully recovered by today at the latest."

At the last moment, I was struck by lightning from an outside source.

No matter how much I had immunity to the 'Divine Status of the Other World', I couldn't avoid being fatally injured if I was exposed to such a high-level being.

If it was a medicine that could fully recover me from such serious injuries in two days... then it must be the 'Life and Death Pill'.

"...Do you understand? So, until then, just be quiet."

A sharp but worried tone. I willingly bowed my head to show my respect.

"Thank you."

Kim Namwoon pretended to be surprised by my greeting, but soon laughed mischievously.

"Heh heh, how can you thank me for something like this?"

「What a polite ahjussi.」

I suddenly wondered why I could hear this kid's inner thoughts.

[Your understanding of the character, 'Kim Namwoon', increases.]

[The exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', is activated.]

The skill was also activated on its own.

Why did this happen often after I collected a fair amount of 'Kim Dokja fragments'?

「Heh heh. It's been a long time since I've heard a thank you.」

I heard it unintentionally, but I felt a little sorry for him.

I wonder if no one in this world says thank you to Kim Namwoon.

Kim Namwoon pushed the wheelchair from behind and asked.

"I heard you're an avatar of that guy. Is that right?"

If you say 'that guy', you must mean 'Kim Dokja'.

I didn't have the confidence to explain the complicated situation to Kim Namwoon, so I just nodded.

"But you're so polite? That guy himself was a bit rude."

Come to think of it, Kim Namwoon was bullied quite a bit by Kim Dokja back then.

Kim Namwoon also kept twitching his lips as if he was recalling that memory.

While passing through the hallway in a short silence, I observed the exterior of the base seen through the window. Then I realized something and opened my mouth.

"Didn't you say that I fainted two days ago?"

"I did."

"Has the base already been restored?"

If I remember correctly, the Gwanghwamun area, including the base, was hit directly by the 'Divine Power of the Other World' and was half destroyed.

However, the scenery of Gwanghwamun seen from outside was surprisingly clean and organized.

"Of course. Our corporation's restoration system is truly the best in the <Star Stream>."

Kim Namwoon said proudly.

"Have you heard of Story Metal? We covered the outer walls of our base with it."

Story Metal.

I couldn't even guess how much astronomical coins it would take to invest to do something like that.

The restoration was still in its final stages, and I could see the incarnations attached to the wall by the window, checking the bonding of Story Metal.

Interestingly, their nationality did not seem to be Korean.

I suddenly thought of the incarnations of Zarathustra I had met in Las Vegas.

"Are they by any chance the craftsmen of 'Zarathustra'?"

"You have quite the eye for it? Yes. After Zarathustra was disbanded, those who had nowhere to go came under our care."

My heart sank for no reason.

I see. Anna Croft of the 1,863rd Round died.

When I thought about it, it was obvious. This was the Last Scenario. Most of the incarnations I know are probably not alive.

Suddenly, the face of Kim Anna-ssi of the 41st Round flashed through my mind.

"Okay, that's the restaurant. Let's eat breakfast first."

I hadn't been up for long, so I wasn't feeling very hungry, but it wouldn't have been polite to ignore the kindness of having brought me here.

I thought I could just eat quietly and leave, but Kim Namwoon, who was pushing the wheelchair, shouted loudly.

"Okay, everyone, get out of the way! His Majesty is coming!"

The people inside the restaurant all turned to look at me.

"Oh, that guy..."

"Is that him?"

There were murmurs from all around.

Kim Namwoon waved his hand around the restaurant, seeming pleased with the attention. Then he pushed my wheelchair to the edge of the wide table and sat down across from me.

"So, what do you want to eat?"

Kim Namwoon handed me the menu. After looking at it, I asked in a suspicious voice.

"Are these dishes really available?"

"Why? Are you surprised?"

Instead of answering, I looked at the food names on the menu once more.

> —Death Devil Tteokbokki (Level 0/Level 1/Level 2/Level 3 (for large intestine only))
>
> —Kimchi fried rice from the ruined lodge (adjustable spiciness)
>
> —Sundae soup from the valley of dawn (mild/spicy)
>
> …

There were at least thirty menu items.

In a world where everything is ruined, how can we still eat this many different foods?

I thought about it for a moment and chose the one that seemed the safest.

"I'll take this."

> —Shy Man's Omelette Rice (optional: demi-glace/ketchup)

Kim Namwoon checked the menu I chose.

And then he muttered.

"Hmm, that's a choice like a handsome man."

I got a little angry, but tried not to show it. Kim Namwoon added with a chuckle.

"Just kidding. Actually, I sometimes eat it when I fight with Jihye."

The food came out quickly.

Kim Namwoon had sundae gukbap. I had omelet rice. After exchanging brief glances, we immediately took our spoons to our rice.

It was a proper meal for the first time in a while. Actually, I didn't expect much from the taste. After all, Yoo Joonghyuk is no longer in this world.

But.

"Huh."

I took a spoonful, then another. When I came to my senses, I had already taken five or six spoonfuls in an instant.

I can't say that my taste buds are sophisticated, but I've even tried Yoo Joonghyuk's cooking. At least I can tell the difference between delicious and tasteless food.

"It's delicious, right?"

I couldn't refute Kim Namwoon's words, which was frustrating.

"Of course. The chef here was brought from the Demon World."

Demon World. I understood many things belatedly. Was that why the names of the foods were all strange?

"Is it the 73rd Demon World? Anyway, it was in that area."

I also knew the chef's name.

「Revolutionary Knight, Marc Xavier.」

The bodyguard of the Demon World who had carried out the 'Revolutionary Scenario' with Kim Dokja.

When I raised my head, I saw Marc carrying plates from afar. As I watched his expression as he wiped away sweat with a bright face, I realized once again that this world was approaching its final destination.

A base made of Story Metal, talents gathered from various regions. And even a great nebula weapon using the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse'.

Even after Kim Dokja left, Han Sooyoung continued to work hard on the scenarios.

She had been desperately struggling to create a complete ending by utilizing every sentence remaining in this world. Perhaps, even though she knew that the world she had created would never be read, she did not give up on the ending of this world in order to keep her promise to just one person.

"Kim Dokja."

Someone poked my shoulder. When I turned around, Han Sooyoung was standing there. I looked up at her, and then suddenly realized something and asked back.

"What did you just say?"

Han Sooyoung looked down at me for a moment, then turned her head and said.

"If you're done eating, come with me. I have something to tell you."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 883 Episode 48 Avatar (6)

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When I was halfway done with the omelet rice, Kim Namwoon took me to the third floor of the base. I thought we were going to meet Han Sooyoung right away, but the place I arrived was the emergency room.

"You've worked hard, Namwoon-ah."

Lee Seolhwa, who was waiting in front of the emergency room, greeted me as she handed me the wheelchair.

Kim Namwoon bashfully frowned and patted my shoulder.

"Then let's meet later, sir."

After Kim Namwoon disappeared, Lee Seolhwa took me and stood in front of the mirror in the supplies room. She busily went around the room, put down a package full of cosmetics on the table, and started to fix my hair.

"What are you doing?"

"Makeup."

"Why all of a sudden?"

"Hmm, because the Captain told me to?"

I couldn't figure out Han Sooyoung's intentions at all.

Why did you make me do that? Do I look so ugly? Or did the 'Ugliest King' effect activate while I was getting the Kim Dokja fragments?

I stared blankly at my face reflected in the mirror. The face in the mirror that I hadn't seen in a long time felt unfamiliar.

Since I had acquired a large quantity of Kim Dokja, my face had become much closer to Kim Dokja than Cheon Inho.

Lee Seolhwa, who had been observing my expression, opened her mouth.

"You look a lot like him."

"Because I'm an avatar."

Without realizing it, A self-deprecating remark. However, Lee Seolhwa tilted her head and smiled as if she had not read my feelings at all.

"Even avatars change their impressions slightly depending on what kind of memories they receive."

It was the first time I heard that story.

Well, Han Sooyoung of the 1,863rd Round was more skilled at using [Avatars] than anyone else.

The colleagues who spent time with her might be able to discern the subtle differences.

"What kind of 'avatar' do I look like?"

"Well..."

She added while cutting my bangs that had grown out a lot.

"I can see that you are someone who neglects self-care."

Self-care.

I smiled bitterly for no reason. I had forgotten for quite some time that such a combination of words was possible.

"Isn't that a luxury in this world?"

"The Captain said that at first too. Until Namwoon went without washing for over two months."

I suddenly remembered that everyone I met after entering the base had clean faces.

"The Captain said that no matter how ruined the world is, we sometimes need to maintain a luxurious lifestyle if we want to exist as humans."

"..."

"Well, it sounds like she just said that for Namwoon to wash."

Lee Seolhwa hummed as she took care of my hair. She cut off my messy hair and trimmed my eyebrows.

"You're good with your hands."

"My hobby is touching up children's hair."

I never thought Lee Seolhwa would have such a hobby.

So Kim Namwoon and Lee Jihye's hair were all Lee Seolhwa's creations.

"When I was young, I wanted to work in the beauty industry."

"Why didn't you?"

"Well, it's an obvious reason. My parents were against it."

The general picture was drawn.

I forgot which round it was, but I remembered reading that Lee Seolhwa graduated from medical school.

"What about Dokja-ssi?"

"Yes?"

"What did Dokja-ssi do before the scenario started?"

"Oh, I was... a writer."

"You're just like our Captain."

I smiled bitterly. Can I say that I'm 'just like' Han Sooyoung?

The styling was finished with the sound of the hair dryer ringing in my ears.

"Okay, done!"

Lee Seolhwa looked into the mirror with a satisfied smile.

"Look, it's much better than before, right?"

It's definitely Kim Dokja's face, but it's subtly different from before. It felt like my impression had come alive.

Lee Seolhwa looked at my face carefully and added with a smile.

"Looking at it like this, it looks like a different person."

I also looked at my face quietly and nodded.

"Thank you."

"Then shall we move?"

Lee Seolhwa personally pushed the wheelchair and guided me to another floor. I thought I would head to the penthouse office, but unexpectedly, I arrived at a large lobby on the 4th floor of the base.

"I haven't been here many times either. The Captain seems to be in a good mood."

As Lee Seolhwa muttered as if she was jealous, the guard waiting at the lobby entrance let me in.

[The 'Soundwave Blocking' skill is activated in the area.]

[The 'Interference Screen' skill is activated in the area.]

…

After passing through the strict security system and narrow entrance, a small living room appeared. The living room, which had a more simple feel than the penthouse office, had a sense of life everywhere.

I realized something for a moment.

This was Han Sooyoung's 'real home.'

The sound of boiling water coming from somewhere, a smell that made my mouth water even though I had just eaten.

Han Sooyoung was boiling ramen in the makeshift kitchen.

"Oh, you're here?"

She must have been reading a book until then, because there was a book with a folded spine on the kitchen table.

『Recorders and Old Thoughts』.

It was a book I had never seen before.

"Do you live here?"

"Yeah."

"What about the penthouse?"

"I can't sleep in a place that's too big."

"There's a chef downstairs, so why ramen?"

Instant ramen.

It was amazing that something like that still existed in this world.

Is it sold at the 'Dokkaebi Bag'?

"If you're going to eat it too, I'll boil two."

"Then... Let's just taste it."

"What about eggs?"

"I tend to put them in."

"What about green onions?"

"It would be nice if there were some."

"What about kimchi?"

"Is there something like that?"

As I heard the sound of eggs breaking, I felt as if I had gone back to before the scenarios had started.

If the scenarios hadn’t started, if Han Sooyoung and I had happened to meet in the same worldline… what would we have talked about?

"Your hair looks good together."

"Seolhwa-ssi touched it."

"You looked happy with Lee Seolhwa."

"Were you watching?"

Han Sooyoung didn’t answer and put kimchi on a small piece of paper and handed it over. I picked up a piece with my chopsticks and tried it. It was definitely the kimchi I knew.

"How are you feeling?"

"I’ve recovered a lot."

I was slowly regaining sensation in my lower body. I thought I could get up if I pushed myself a little harder.

Soon, a bowl of well-cooked ramen was placed in front of me. I swallowed without realizing it. Han Sooyoung said, perhaps sensing my state of mind.

"Eat."

I picked up a chopstick without hesitation. The moment I filled my mouth with the moderately chewy noodles, an ecstatic sensation captured the tip of my tongue.

How long has it been since I ate ramen?

I don't know if I can say this, but it was as moving as the first time I ate Yoo Joonghyuk's cooking.

They say that the taste you know is the scariest.

"Is it delicious?"

"It is delicious."

We ate ramen in a quiet silence.

"Do you eat ramen every day?"

"Not every day, but maybe once every two days?"

"It's not good for your health."

"You're saying the same thing as Lee Hyunsung."

Han Sooyoung laughed as she said that.

It was the first time I saw her laugh so clearly, so I blankly stared at her for a moment before going back to eating the ramen.

"There's something I need to apologize for."

"An apology?"

"When you fell asleep, in your incarnation, I saw your stories."

Han Sooyoung handed me water as I coughed.

"I didn't try to see it on purpose. Really."

Han Sooyoung's words must be true.

I was hit by the attack of the 'Divine Being of the Other World' and collapsed, so it wouldn't have been strange if she had confirmed some of my stories while healing me.

The problem is how much of my stories she's seen...

If she's seen things she shouldn't have seen, then I've caused a great deal of damage to the worldview of the main story just by existing.

"How much have you seen?"

"That you come from a very unique worldline."

"And?"

"That you're not just an 'avatar'."

My heart felt cold. All sorts of thoughts came and went in my head.

I wonder if it's okay. Maybe Han Sooyoung found out information she shouldn't know.

Whether she knew what I was thinking or not, Han Sooyoung spoke while cracking the half-broken egg with her chopsticks.

"It's not easy to endure. The fact that there is another me besides me."

The sentence flowed naturally like cracking an egg. Perhaps Han Sooyoung in front of me was the one who understood such a life better than anyone else.

For a moment, I was overcome with the desire to tell her everything I knew.

"Am I real or fake? Who am I, and how much of me am I? Are my memories truly mine?"

Maybe I could change this messed-up story that I ruined.

Maybe I could bring Kim Dokja back to this world that has lost him.

"Kim Dokja."

"Why do you call me Kim Dokja?"

"What do you think determines existence?"

I hesitated, unable to answer the sudden question right away. However, Han Sooyoung didn't seem to be waiting for my answer in the first place.

"I think it's actions."

Actions.

"The actions we choose at crucial moments. Those actions pile up and become history, and history becomes a story."

And the story again determines who we are.

"In that sense, I thought you were Kim Dokja. That’s why I’m calling you Kim Dokja."

I didn’t know what to say, so I lowered my head for a moment.

"What’s that expression? Are you happy or sad?"

"Both."

Han Sooyoung smiled bitterly.

"You asked me to send you back to your worldline."

"Yes."

"Do you really want to go back?"

"I have to go back."

"You have to go back."

Han Sooyoung repeated that answer as if it was funny.

"In the worldline you lived in, you must have risked your life countless times for the people you cherished. You must have constantly created things you had to protect and obsessively protected them. That must have been how you, and how Kim Dokja, existed as Kim Dokja."

I couldn’t say anything.

"But you know. Will you be able to be happy in the ending of a story made that way?"

Happiness.

I flinched involuntarily at the unfamiliar word I had never thought of.

"What choice will a being who can only feel useful by saving someone make when there is nothing left to save?"

A faint shiver ran down my spine.

For a moment, such a thought occurred to me.

I wondered if she already knew everything, what had happened to Kim Dokja, or if she had anticipated everything.

Han Sooyoung put down her chopsticks and stood up, saying,

"You can still choose your ending."

Before I could even ask what that meant, Han Sooyoung started pushing my wheelchair.

She crossed the living room and headed toward the balcony. When she opened the balcony window, the incarnations waiting under Gwanghwamun all looked up at us.

"Oh—!"

"They're finally out!"

Along with the commotion, people's cheers could be heard from below the balcony.

I asked, a little flustered.

"Why are all these people gathered here?"

Han Sooyoung waved at them and answered.

"I called them. I wanted to introduce you to the people."

"So why..."

"You don't have a scenario yet."

Han Sooyoung added with a grin.

"There are several ways to get a scenario."

There were incarnations here, and the Constellations they had contracted with.

In other words, Han Sooyoung is now.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', admires your spirit.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', asks if that man is really the hero who protected Gwanghwamun.]

[The Constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', likes your hairstyle.]

[A very small number of Constellations say that you look more neat than they thought.]

She wants to imprint my existence on the Constellations of the Last Scenario.

[All the Constellations of the Korean Peninsula are looking at you.]

The Last Scenario.

The few stars left in this world were focused on me. Following the desires of the stars, I could hear the faint sound of probability moving.

[The Management Bureau acknowledges your contribution in this scenario.]

[You will be assigned a new scenario.]

The moment I heard the message echoing in my head, I thought I knew why Han Sooyoung had dressed me up and why she had called me to this place.

"You don’t have to save anyone anymore. You don’t have to live as the Demon King of Salvation. You don’t have to become the Kim Dokja that people want."

Han Sooyoung was now showing me her world.

A world nearing its end.

Before the end of that story, Han Sooyoung was telling me.

"You are one here."

That there is a place for me in this world too. No, maybe this is the world where I can exist as my 'real me'.

"You don’t necessarily have to see the 'ending' in the worldline you lived in. So—"

Han Sooyoung’s hand was faintly shaking. With her hand firmly wrapped around my shoulder, Han Sooyoung said.

"This time, let’s see the ending of this world together."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 884 Episode 48 Avatar (7)

During the short banquet, Han Sooyoung introduced me to the people.

"He's my friend."

I didn't know she would introduce me like that, so I blankly looked up at Han Sooyoung. The people listening to the story also looked perplexed.

Some people were surprised, asking if the Captain had a friend, while others nodded their heads, saying that they could trust the Captain's friend.

Han Sooyoung laughed as if she found those people's reactions funny and added,

"I'm joking. In fact, this guy is a messenger from another worldline. He came to help our world before the Final Scenario. Don't ignore him and treat him well."

It was an explanation that lacked some important details. I wondered if people would be convinced by that, but surprisingly, the response was not bad.

"If he came to help, then he's welcome."

"If the Captain brought him here, I think there must be a reason."

Even the Constellations agreed.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', nods his head.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', says, 'If that's the case, then I can believe it.']

However, it wasn't because my existence was probable, but because of Han Sooyoung's overwhelming charisma.

To be honest, the people here would believe Han Sooyoung's words even if she made a 'Life and Death Ring' out of stones.

"Han Sooyoung! Han Sooyoung!"

Everyone who survived until the Last Scenario was calling her name.

Even though they were just calling her name and hearing her name, I somehow felt like I knew what kind of story she had been through.

Even if all of this was an elaborate production for a 'False Ending,' it was a scene that made me think that I would gladly be fooled by this kind of production.

"Kim Dokja!"

And then, from somewhere, someone else appeared calling my name.

"You're handsome!"

Only after hearing those words did I understand why Han Sooyoung had Lee Seolhwa dress me up.

[A new scenario has arrived!]

That's when the scenario alarm came up.

The scenario was the minimum justification for me to exist in this world.

It was proof that the direction she had built up had been recognized by the Dokkaebis and Constellations.

I immediately checked the scenario content.

**<Sub-scenario - Uninvited Guest>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: Solve the problem of the relevant worldline and find a way to return to the worldline you belong to.

Time limit: 30 days

Reward: ???

Failure: Disappearance of the incarnation body.

A sub-scenario, not the main scenario.

After all, I didn't perform the main scenario in this world from the beginning, so I guess I'm not given the right to the 'Last Scenario'.

By the way, the assignment content was a bit strange.

'Solve the problem of the relevant worldline and find a way to return to the original worldline?'

Even if I can go back, what's wrong with this worldline? No matter how much I look around, I don't feel like there's any particular problem. The subtitle of the scenario was 'Uninvited Guest', which also bothered me. What on earth was the management office thinking when they came up with this scenario?

Whether or not she knew my thoughts, Han Sooyoung waved her hand at the people and muttered.

"If you're going to stay here from now on, it'd be good to get to know the people."

"..."

"That guy left without any feelings, but I'm saying this because I think you're different."

"What you said earlier..."

In fact, throughout the banquet, Han Sooyoung's words were lingering in a corner of my head.

「"This time, let's see the end of this world together."」

Han Sooyoung shook her head as if she knew what I was going to say.

"Don't take it to heart. It's just something I said."

"Oh, really?"

"But if you stay here for a week, you'll probably just want to sit down."

I could sense a strange sense of confidence in her voice.

"I don't know which scenario your worldline is in, but... It won't be easy to go back after playing through scenario number 99 with a max level character."

"I'm not a max level character."

"Anyway."

"And this isn't my first time coming to scenario number 99."

"What?"

I've already performed Cheon Inho's 40th Round through the 'Time Fault'.

In that 40th Round, I definitely performed the 'Last Scenario'. Even if it was a re-experience.

"Is your worldline also scenario number 99?"

"That's not it."

"Then?"

"I can't tell you the details."

Han Sooyoung looked at me with a strange expression and pursed her lips.

"But isn't this place more fun? It's not like all scenario 99 are the same."

That's right. Han Sooyoung's 1,863rd Round was definitely different from Cheon Inho's 40th Round.

Unlike Cheon Inho, she had many colleagues.

"And in the worldline you came from, there's no 'me' either?"

My heart prickled at those words.

"Yes. There isn't anymore."

"Then there's no one waiting for you."

"I don't know why you're so sure, but I have people waiting for me too."

"Really? How many of them?"

I pictured the faces of the readers in my head. Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Cha Sungwoo, Cha Yerin, Ye Hyunwoo. And Ji Eunyu…

Then, for a moment, a strange thought occurred to me.

Are they really waiting for me?

「They needed 'Kim Dokja' more than anyone else.」

But could I be a 'Kim Dokja' enough for them?

Han Sooyoung added a word as if driving a nail into that question.

"Are you really what those people need?"

Han Sooyoung's expression was triumphant, as if she had read the history of my life.

Instead of resisting that triumph, I asked this.

"Why do you want me to be here?"

Han Sooyoung didn't answer right away, but looked up at the distant night sky and said after a short pause.

"You said it. You'll help me get over the 'Final Wall'?"

The Final Wall.

Beyond that distant night sky, there is definitely the last gate that Han Sooyoung must overcome.

"Am I really the one you need?"

The few remaining starlights were shining on us. The light was so dim that Han Sooyoung's expression was obscured by the darkness and could not be seen clearly.

---

The next morning, Kim Namwoon woke me up.

"The Captain said to take you with me. Can you walk now?"

I nodded.

The effectiveness of the Life and Death Ring was certainly different. The lower half of my body, which had not listened to me until yesterday, felt light today as if it had been reborn.

"No problem."

"Then follow me."

Kim Namwoon left those words behind and walked ahead.

"Is there anything I need to do?"

"Well, there's nothing in particular."

I wondered why it was Kim Namwoon among all the people, but upon closer inspection, he seemed to be the most idle person in the base.

"The Captain just told me to show you some people and introduce you to the work."

"What about Han Sooyoung?"

"The Captain is always busy."

Well, leading this kind of force would require a lot of work to be done from the morning. Unlike the relatively small <Kim Dokja Company>, <Han Sooyoung Corporation> really seemed to have a lot of employees.

Kim Namwoon walked around the base with an annoyed expression and introduced me to the facilities.

"This is a bathroom for executives only, and over there is a PC room that Jihye often goes to."

"Is there a PC room?"

"Of course. It's a computer made with magic engineering, so it doesn't run the latest games. Anyway, the facility down there is a billiard hall that Jihye sometimes goes to, and over there is a library that Jihye hates..."

Something about the explanation is tilted toward the person who has already explained it.

"Damn, I feel like I'm a game NPC right now. Do you know about NPCs, sir?"

"I do."

"Oh, do you like games?"

As if he thought he had found something in common, Kim Namwoon started talking about the games he liked for a while. I suddenly remembered that Kim Namwoon was a high school student.

"Ahem, I'm the only one talking too much, sorry."

"It's okay."

"Jihye doesn't like talking like this."

I watched Kim Namwoon scratching his head with a slightly sad heart.

Is it because of Han Sooyoung that the Delusion Demon Kim Namwoon has changed like this, or is it because of the environment of the 1,863rd Round?

"But now that I'm looking at you, sir, I understand why the Captain told me to bring you around."

"...?"

"You look depressed."

I was momentarily speechless at the unexpected insight.

I look depressed.

When I looked at the expression reflected in the passing window, I really did look a little depressed.

If I were to look for a reason, I could find one. But I didn't want to think about it.

Looking back, not a single thing has gone as planned since I was reincarnated into this world. It was the same at the Recycling Center and in the Fear Realm.

That's how I arrived at the 1,863rd Round.

For some reason, Han Sooyoung left me in Kim Namwoon's hands, and I was thrown into the Last Scenario of an unfamiliar worldline, listening to Kim Namwoon talk about games.

I turned my smartphone off and on several times, thinking that if I said something to someone, things would get better, but I couldn't contact my Eldest Brother.

In fact, it would be a problem even if I had contacted him.

As you can see, I must have heard that reading 'Ways of Survival' would make things better.

"I've been like that before, too. I've overcome it all now, but cheer up. Everyone has difficult times."

"Yes."

That's comforting.

I replied casually and looked out the window at the scenery of Gwanghwamun.

It's just as Han Sooyoung said.

Even though it's the same scenario 99, the scenery of the world is so different.

Even in a world without Kim Dokja, people can 'get close to the ending'.

I wonder if everyone is doing well.

Do Yoo Joonghyuk and other readers remember me? How much time has passed there? What happened to Ji Eunyu and Heewon-ssi?

Was it because the sunset reflected on the window was so beautiful, or was it because the expressions of the people looking at the sunset were so warm?

I thought about that for a moment.

「Am I still a valid person in this story?」

That’s when I heard a loud thud from inside the base.

I turned my head wondering what had happened, and Kim Namwoon shook my shoulder as if it was nothing. He shrugged.

"I guess it's almost training time."

Training time?

Kim Namwoon guided me to the underground training grounds as if to resolve my doubts.

At the entrance to the training grounds, several incarnations were gathered here and there, looking at a huge screen.

There happened to be a familiar figure in front of the screen.

"Are you here?"

"Yes, Jihye."

"I told you not to greet me like that."

"Sorry."

I looked up at the screen together from behind the two of them. The man on the screen was a person I knew well.

"Oh, what. Is Hyunsung-ssi in good condition today?"

As expected from the Last Scenario, Lee Hyunsung, who boasted vicious latissimus dorsi and serratus anterior, was swinging his fists with his upper body exposed.

"The Captain made it. It's a kind of grand battle simulation based on a legend from the past."

The background was a dry desert. Every time Lee Hyunsung moved his fist, huge craters appeared all over the desert.

Is it [Mt. Taesun Smash]? If it's like that, it could really destroy a mountain, just like its name suggests.

Boom! Boom! Boom! Boom!

It seems that was the source of the loud noise I've been hearing since a while ago.

"After entering, if you choose a specific legend, you can fight the character in the legend."

I roughly understood the system.

Anyway, if they're going to face Lee Hyunsung who's gotten that strong, the enemy in the simulation must be amazing.

A delicate and beautiful sword fight that occasionally appeared through the sandstorm. The fist and the blade crossed, and an ecstatic storm of legends rose.

Is the opponent a Constellation?

What if that Constellation is that good at swordsmanship?

A loud noise as if the sky was breaking rang out every time the sword fight flashed in the hazy sky.

Wait a minute, no way.

When I saw the black coat fluttering in the thick dust, I realized how the characters in this worldline could become so strong.

Some stories remain in people's hearts like shadows even after they reach their conclusion and do not disappear.

"I wonder if Hyunsung ahjussi can win this time."

On the screen, Lee Hyunsung and Yoo Joonghyuk from the 1,863rd Round were fighting.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 885 Episode 48 Avatar (8)

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In 'Ways of Survival', Lee Hyunsung and Yoo Joonghyuk fight frequently. Of course, most of them were mock battles ordered by Yoo Joonghyuk ("We will conduct a combat stamina test in preparation for the next scenario"), and they were part of a special training plan to strengthen Lee Hyunsung's tanking ability.

「"Get up, Lee Hyunsung."」

Yoo Joonghyuk only repeats that phrase throughout the mock battle. That's because in his sparring with Yoo Joonghyuk, Lee Hyunsung is constantly getting beaten up and falling down.

Falling down, getting up, falling down, getting up.

An incarnation body that has been forged hundreds and thousands of times, just like refining steel. That was Lee Hyunsung, the Steel Sword Emperor of 'Ways of Survival'.

However, the 1,863rd Round's battle unfolding before my eyes was strangely different from the 'Ways of Survival' that I knew.

"Oh! He hit him with one shot!"

Unlike Lee Hyunsung of 'Ways of Survival' who felt goosebumps and trauma just by looking at Yoo Joonghyuk, Lee Hyunsung of the 1,863rd Round was calm.

Lee Hyunsung, who fought by turning the entire desert upside down, a wave of extraordinary magical power rose from his fist.

Kim Namwoon, who was watching from the side, muttered in admiration.

"Wow, he's mastered that technique too?"

With a loud noise like a mountain collapsing, a magical light exploded from his fist.

「Byeokryeokilkwon.」

The martial art of 'Kwon-wang', a transcendental left-hander from Murim. In addition, his technique to avoid Yoo Joonghyuk's [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] was Lee Jihye's specialty, [Ghost Walk].

"No, I told you several times that you shouldn't walk like that!"

Lee Jihye, who was watching, pursed her lips and said. Even though it wasn't perfect, the fact that Lee Hyunsung could freely use the skills of other incarnations shocked me greatly.

「It's different from 'Ways of Survival'.」

Come to think of it, Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round used [Black Flame] even though she didn't make a contract with the Black Flame Dragon.

Perhaps they were constantly developing the combat abilities they didn't have by repeating the simulation.

"That's right! Push!"

Lee Hyunsung fought desperately. He calmly deflected Yoo Joonghyuk's attacks, countered the attacks he couldn't deflect, and punched him without hesitation whenever he saw an opening.

Since his opponent was Yoo Joonghyuk, he ended up losing the overall fight, but his improvisation and situational management skills were astonishing.

If Yoo Joonghyuk of 'Ways of Survival' had been by his side, Lee Hyunsung would have definitely received a 'Battle Physical Test S-Rank'.

Kim Namwoon asked.

"Isn't our ahjussi great?"

I nodded and kept my eyes on Lee Hyunsung's battle.

Beyond mere desperation, it was a battle that felt like a desperate battle. That was the only way I could describe it.

The story contained in each punch and kick was telling the story of Lee Hyunsung.

I didn't know why he kept fighting with that face. I just vaguely guessed that there must be something he wanted to protect just as much.

Kwaaaaah!

The suffocating close combat finally ended.

[The story simulation '1,863–004' ends.]

The smoky dust on the screen disappeared, and the door to the training capsule that Lee Hyunsung had entered opened.

"You did well, ahjussi."

Lee Jihye handed a towel to Lee Hyunsung, who was drenched in sweat.

"Thank you."

"It was too bad. I thought we would win this time."

Lee Hyunsung shook his head with a bitter smile. But the next moment, he turned his head towards me. We stared at each other for about three seconds. When I bowed first, Lee Hyunsung also responded.

"You're the person the Captain brought."

In some rounds, Lee Hyunsung was always a kind person. To Kim Dokja and to his colleagues.

But why?

Strangely, there was a faint sense of wariness in the way Lee Hyunsung spoke to me.

[The character, 'Lee Hyunsung', is suspicious of you.]

What?

"Nice to meet you. Please take care of me."

This man, who seemed to be reaching out to me on the outside, seemed suspicious of me on the inside.

Why?

If I had to pick a reason, it wasn't that hard to guess. He might not like me, who suddenly fell from the sky like a parachute (I really did fall from the sky), and appeared at Han Sooyoung's introduction.

Lee Hyunsung looked at me for a moment, then turned around and walked out of the training grounds.

---

One day, two days, three days passed again.

During that time, Kim Namwoon dragged me to training grounds and PC rooms, and whenever he had the chance, he would harass me by saying things like, "Let’s have a go."

What was Han Sooyoung thinking when she told me to meet people?

「There are 27 days left.」

I checked the scenario again anxiously. In the next 27 days, I had to solve the problem of this worldline and find a way to return to my worldline.

However, I had no idea what the problem of this worldline was.

So I tried to sneak a hint to Kim Namwoon once.

"Problem? Well, Jihye doesn’t really react when I talk to her."

Surely that wasn’t the 'worldline problem'.

I asked Lee Jihye as well.

"You mean my swordsmanship hasn’t improved much lately?"

"It can’t be the only thing you’ve got to worry about?"

"Kim Namwoon keeps on hanging around? Why?"

This didn't seem like a grand enough problem to be called a 'worldline problem'.

To the same question, Lee Seolhwa answered as follows.

"Loneliness, isn't it?"

"Loneliness?"

This time, I was a little surprised by the somewhat abstract answer.

Loneliness. An emotion that everyone experiences, to varying degrees, as a human being.

But is there a reason why that would be a 'problem' in particular?

Ah.

Now that I think about it, 'Yoo Joonghyuk' is no longer in this round. I wondered if the loneliness Lee Seolhwa felt was related to that, but Lee Seolhwa smiled and added.

"It's a story about the Captain."

"Han Sooyoung is lonely?"

I opened my mouth as if to protest without realizing it.

"How could she be lonely when she has such great colleagues?"

Han Sooyoung's 1,863rd Round was close to perfect.

She reached the Final Scenario without Yoo Joonghyuk. Even in the Final Scenario, the fact that so many incarnations survived was something that even Yoo Joonghyuk of 'Ways of Survival' couldn't do.

"That's not the problem."

"Is that so?"

Lee Seolhwa didn't answer. For a moment, she made a strange expression like a broken doll, and then suddenly acted out.

"How are you feeling?"

"I'm fine."

"That's fortunate."

"But what you just said—"

"I have something to do, so I'll go first."

It was a conversation that left only a sense of uneasiness.

After work, I returned to my assigned dorm. I had many worries about the scenario, but it was hard to remember the last time a day passed by so peacefully like today.

As I sat on the soft chair and looked at my face in the mirror, I remembered something I had heard in passing.

Did you say I looked depressed?

That thought suddenly occurred to me. If I am influenced by them every time I get a fragment of Kim Dokja, then my current 'depression' may also be related to Kim Dokja.

So…

"Kim Dokja, are you watching?"

I tried speaking to him while looking in the mirror, but there was no answer.

Well, if they were the kind of people who would respond when I spoke to them like this, they would have contacted me already.

I thought for a moment, then turned on my smartphone and opened the web novel app. It was to check the comments on the platform for the first time in a while. In times like now when there is insufficient information, it was best to use a platform that allows short-term future vision.

[Current connection is not smooth.]

However, the site connection was not smooth.

Why is that? Is it because this is a different worldline?

Wiiing.

I was startled by the vibration sound that rang for a moment and looked at the screen.

[A new message has arrived.]

There are already people who will send messages to this smartphone.

To be exact, there are only two.

As expected, the sender was my hyung.

—Round 896 of Ways of Survival

That was the end of the message. It was a rare contact, but I was disappointed.

The content of the message he sent was also 'Round 896 of Ways of Survival'.

But thinking about it again, I was grateful that he sent me even a short message.

Seven characters that were sent at the risk of probability in a situation where even the platform connection was not smooth.

If this was Kim Dokja's message, there must be a reason.

I immediately opened the text file of 'Round 896 of Ways of Survival'.

I scrolled down, and down again.

Soon after, I found the 'Round 896' of Ways of Survival that Kim Dokja had mentioned.

「And Yoo Joonghyuk opened his eyes.」

Yoo Joonghyuk in the 896th round was the same as Yoo Joonghyuk any other time.

The first scenario started on the subway.

Yoo Joonghyuk calmly obtained the necessary items and then proceeded with the scenario. As I followed the smooth progression without any unnecessary details, I realized once again what kind of life Yoo Joonghyuk had lived.

Life was a habit to him.

The sincerity of repeating the same thing over and over again without getting tired of it. That sincerity is what ultimately made Yoo Joonghyuk.

「"You die."」

Of course, his personality became a bit twisted in return.

「"You die too."」

He became a strange person who only repeated the word "die" whenever he got the chance.

「"You survive."」

In the midst of all this, Yoo Joonghyuk faithfully saved those who needed to live, and took them as his comrades. Yoo Joonghyuk continued to advance while carrying out the 'Absolute Throne' scenario with them and fighting against various Nebulae.

After going through the 'Demon King Selection Tournament', 'Gigantomachia', 'Ragnarok', and 'The Holy Demon War'—he encountered several crises and cleared scenarios that seemed impossible to solve. I also followed Yoo Joonghyuk's journey.

Did I acquire too many Kim Dokja fragments?

It had been a long time since I felt reading—and especially 'Ways of Survival'—interesting.

I didn't want to miss this flow, so I forgot about my problems for a moment and immersed myself in Yoo Joonhyuk's story.

How much did I read like that?

「And Yoo Joonghyuk reached the Final Scenario.」

I finally reached that sentence. And only then did I realize the strange sense of discomfort I had felt throughout reading the 896th Round.

"Huh?"

Something felt strange.

The 'Final Scenario'?

That couldn't be.

As far as I know, except for the 1,863rd Round, the only time he got close to the 'Final Scenario' was in the 999th Round.

But in the 896th Round, which was 100 rounds earlier, he reached the 'Final Scenario'?

Did the content of Ways of Survival change?

Or am I remembering something wrong?

But regardless of my memory, Yoo Joonghyuk continued with the scenario, and even.

「That's how he cleared the Last Scenario.」

He even cleared the 'Last Scenario'.

「At the end of every scenario, he slowly looked back at the world. His colleagues laughing unrealistically, the ending he had so desperately wanted.」

But Yoo Joonghyuk, who was quietly staring at that scenery, let out a bitter laugh.

「"I see."」

And he muttered.

「"This world is fake."」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 886 Episode 48 Avatar (9)

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I paused at that part for a long time.

This world is fake.

It was just one sentence.

Even so, I couldn't fully fathom the temptation that Yoo Joonghyuk had to resist in order to reach the conclusion of that one sentence.

「"Stop joking and come out. I now know that this world is an illusion."」

The feeling of having to deny his own end after reaching the end he had so desperately wanted.

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk hoped that no one would answer his question while saying those words.

「[That's amazing, Supreme King. How did you figure that out?]」

A voice that shattered illusions.

He was a Constellation that I also knew.

One of the Twelve Gods of the great <Olympus>, and the Constellation that provided a story to Cheon Inho in the 40th Round.

「Hermes, the Master of the Skywalk.」

It was the moment when the identity of the '896th Round' was finally revealed.

「[I'll ask again. How did you find out?]」

In fact, Yoo Joonghyuk's actual incarnation body was still in the 895th Round, and he was on the verge of death.

However, <Olympus>, which acquired his incarnation body that was on the verge of death, delayed his death and connected it to Hermes's 'Big Data System'.

As a result, <Olympus> succeeded in making Yoo Joonghyuk wake up in the 'Terrarium', an imaginary world created based on Yoo Joonghyuk's memories. Not only that, they even led him to believe that world was the '896th Round' and live there.

The so-called 'Terraria Project'.

It was the ultimate trap designed by <Olympus> to uncover the secret of [Regression] and find out Yoo Joonghyuk's scenario pattern.

「"I just knew it."」

Yoo Joonghyuk calmly accepted all of the facts and answered.

「"There's no way I could be this lucky."」

Looking back at his surviving comrades, seeing his wish that had never been fulfilled come true before his eyes, Yoo Joonghyuk blinked his eyes indifferently.

He then grabbed his sword in reverse and aimed it at his heart.

「[Wait. Stop!]」

Hermes stopped Yoo Joonghyuk.

「[I can leave this world for you.]」

「"What's the point of that?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk's blazing anger turned to Hermes.

He had been robbed of his freedom, his comrades. He had been robbed of the truth. He had been robbed of his joy and sorrow. And now, in front of the stars who had taken away even his story and turned it into their amusement, Yoo Joonghyuk was speaking.

「"Until the day my life ends, I will never forgive you guys."」

「[Of course. But there are no Constellations left in this worldline for you to take revenge on. They were all destroyed by the aftershock of probability while trying to imitate your [Regression].]」

The ending of the 'Terrarium Project' was terrible. The Constellations of <Olympus> were caught up in the aftershock of probability in the process of digging up the secret of the 'Oldest Dream' and [Regression] that they had been desperately trying to know.

While recreating the [Regression] stigma based on Yoo Joonghyuk's memories, they failed to calm the 'Great Tale' that caused the Myth-grade Constellations to run wild, resulting in a catastrophe that caused the entire <Star Stream> to collapse.

Yoo Joonghyuk mocked Hermes.

「"There's still the next Round, and the one after that."」

Hermes replied with a bitter smile.

「[I know. You'll try to kill us again and again. Just like you did in your past life. Your lonely revenge on the Constellations who don't even remember the last Round will continue forever. But are you really satisfied with that?]」

「"What are you trying to say?"」

「[The Puppet of the Oldest Dream.]」

Hermes was silent for a moment after saying that. Although his thoughts were not described, I, who was reading the story outside the lines, could feel Hermes's emotions that were not described.

「[Do you really think that this world you lived in is an 'illusion'?]」

In the <Star Stream> where the Constellations died, the only world that survived now was the 'Terrarium' where Yoo Joonghyuk exists.

「[The world of the <Star Stream> where you lived is also just a dream of a great cosmic being. If that's the case anyway, wouldn't it be okay to stay in the Terrarium I created?]」

In the 895th Round, which was on the verge of destruction, Yoo Joonghyuk was the last 'story' left to Hermes.

「[You just have to forget. If you just forget that this world is a lie, you can be happy again. You can reach the ending that you couldn't find in the <Star Stream>.]」

「"The 'ending' I want doesn't exist in the world you created."」

Yoo Joonghyuk stabbed his own heart without hesitation.

Hermes muttered bitterly.

「[Lonely Regressor. You will make even the stars that have come to like you lonely.]」

With those words, the 'Terrarium' created by Hermes collapsed, and Yoo Joonghyuk's real '896th Round' began.

Why did Kim Dokja tell me to read this Round?

I couldn't quite understand it.

Could it be a hint that this world wasn't the real 1,863rd Round, but a kind of 'Time Fault'?

However, I couldn't feel the time density characteristic of a Fault at all.

Furthermore, there was no task that was announced when entering the 'Time Fault'.

Or simply, could this world also be a 'Terrarium' created by Hermes?

I took a moment to gather my thoughts, then slowly reviewed the contents of the 896th Round I had just read.

Upon closer inspection, I saw a passage that I had overlooked earlier.

「It was a difficult and arduous task to build a 'world' to deceive a Regressor who had repeated hundreds of lives.」

…

So, Hermes thought. The one who would create this 'Terrarium' should be Yoo Joonghyuk himself, not himself. In other words, it should be a world where the Regressor himself deceives himself.

…

To help with that process, Hermes borrowed a unique skill, and the name of that skill was…」

The moment I read that far, a sharp ringing sounded in the air.

Beep beep—

As I opened the door and went outside, I saw people busily moving around the base.

"What's going on?"

"It's an attack!"

It was early morning.

It was definitely a time when it was vulnerable to an attack, but who would dare attack this base?

Once again, a kung sound rang out and the upper part of the building was destroyed.

At that moment, Kim Namwoon, who had come running down from the upper floor, asked.

"Whoa! Ahjussi, are you okay?"

"Yes, I'm okay, but—"

"Don't crawl out for no reason and stay here. Got it?"

I couldn't really stay still just because I heard those words.

The sound of sergeants clashing and screams could be heard alternately from outside the base.

As I hurriedly went down to the first floor, I saw Lee Seolhwa, who was waiting with the medical team. Beyond them, Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, Kim Namwoon, and other

members of <Han Sooyoung Corporation> were engaged in a fierce battle with something.

But the sight of the opponent engaged in a fierce battle seemed familiar.

If my eyes weren't wrong, it was definitely one of the Twelve Gods of <Olympus>.

Ares, the Ferocious God of War.

But it was different from the 'Ares' I knew.

He was not the 'Ferocious Lord' who boasted of his splendid armor and relics.

His skin was distorted by burns like a burnt zombie. His muscles were cut off here and there, making him look ugly.

I was able to recognize him because of the story fragments floating around his base.

[Story fragment, 'Echoes of Ferociousness', continues its storytelling.]

It wasn't just Ares.

All the Twelve Gods of <Olympus> that I knew, including Hephaestus, Artemis, and Athena, were roaming the battlefield like zombies.

"They're the dregs of the Constellations."

Lee Seolhwa said.

"They're like the wills of dead Constellations. Constellations that had powerful stories sometimes remain as stories and wander the world even after death."

As if to prove her words, the Twelve Gods were speaking.

[Evil... Director... ]

[The <Star Stream> you destroyed… will not forgive you… ]

[You… cannot see… ■■… ]

[No one in this world… ■■… wants… ]

I don't know what they're talking about, but it was clear that they had hostility towards this side.

Even if they are dead, a Constellation of the highest rank is still a Constellation of the highest rank.

The fierce waves of the Lion’s Wrath that flowed from Ares’s mouth swept through the base.

"Hyunsung ahjussi!"

Lee Hyunsung’s [Area Defense] skill covered the party. However, there were enemies who entered through the gap.

Hephaestus, who had climbed over the defense wall with his half-twisted limbs. Even the Constellations of <Olympus> were following him.

"Damn it! The left side is pierced!"

"Shin Yoosung!"

Then, the 'Chimera Dragon' appeared along with a shadow that covered the sky far and wide. With Shin Yoosung’s signal, the 'Chimera Dragon’s' breath tore through the earth, turning it into scorched earth.

Taking advantage of the time the breath gave her, Lee Jihye grumbled as she crossed inside the barrier.

"There are too many. Damn it, if only we could have used the power of the Apocalypse Dragon—"

The power of the Apocalypse Dragon.

I thought of the power of the other world that Han Sooyoung had used to save me a while ago.

Maybe because they wasted too much probability back then, they don’t have enough energy to deal with the enemies now.

Now that I think about it, where did Han Sooyoung go?

"Lee Jihye! The right side is also pierced!"

Along with Kim Namwoon’s shout, Ares and other Constellations came running, limping in their half-broken incarnation bodies.

The direction they were running from was the direction I and Lee Seolhwa were in. Lee Seolhwa, with her expression hardened, was about to step forward, when I pulled out my sword first.

"Please stand back."

If things were like this because of me, I couldn’t just sit back and watch.

I took a deep breath and focused on the story inside me.

I saw Ares, who had noticed me, licking his lips.

[You…?]

I pulled out my sword without giving him a chance to speak. What I needed right now was a quick decision. If they didn’t know my identity, then I had a better chance of winning.

Kiiing!

The ether blade that rose from 'Unbreakable Faith'. The stories I had built up were embedded in the Blade of Faith.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', roars!]

I don’t know if it was another Narrative-grade Constellation, but at least in my current state, I wouldn’t be pushed back by this guy.

Because I’ve already cut him down as the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

[Kuaaaaah!]

As Ares, who was cut by 'Unbreakable Faith', screamed and flinched, I took advantage of the gap.

Kim Namwoon and Lee Jihye rushed forward and struck back, blowing Ares's head off.

"Nice, ahjussi!"

Kim Namwoon cheered and waved his hand at me.

But instead of reacting to him, I stared at the battlefield with calm eyes.

「It was a perfect Round.」

No matter how much they were just scraps of Constellations, the Constellations once represented a single Giant Nebula. Against them, the members of <Han Sooyoung Corporation> were barely harmed and protecting each other.

「That's why it was an impossible Turn.」

A strange sense of discomfort ran down my spine once again.

The wall that Yoo Joonghyuk, who had regressed 999 times, could not overcome even after sacrificing his own incarnation body, was the 'Last Scenario' of the <Star Stream>.

I knew that Han Sooyoung was outstanding. But even for her, would it be possible for her to reach this scenario with all her colleagues? And no one was hurt—

"Dokja-ssi."

Lee Seolhwa suddenly approached me and asked.

"Are you hurt anywhere?"

"Yes, how are the others?"

"It's okay, there are some with minor injuries..."

I saw patients being carried on beds. The patients were shedding stories from their cuts and torn wounds.

「Shedding stories.」

I blankly stared at the injured, then turned my head to look at Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye, and Lee Hyunsung.

They were also shedding stories from their wounds.

Of course, shedding stories wasn't that strange. When Constellations were injured, they would shed stories from their incarnation bodies. The noble Transcendental Constellations also shed stories when they suffered deep internal injuries or were struck at their source.

But this case was a bit unusual.

General incarnations don't shed stories instead of blood.

Except for one case.

「If the incarnation is not the 'main body'.」

I thought that was impossible.

Even if it was Han Sooyoung, there was no way that it could be possible.

But the faint sparks that swept across the entire battlefield—the reality before my eyes supported that possibility.

「A way to reach the Final Scenario without anyone dying.」

Just as Kim Dokja, who had overcome the 'Final Wall' with his comrades, had to shoulder the 'Oldest Dream', there was always a price to pay for those who dream impossible dreams.

So what price did Han Sooyoung pay to get here?

"Seolhwa-ssi."

Lee Seolhwa's eyes were shaking as she looked into my eyes.

As if she already knew what I was going to ask.

"Han Sooyoung, where is she right now?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 887 Episode 48 Avatar (10)

"Sooyoung-ssi will be resting for a while. She hasn’t recovered from the aftereffects of using the power of the 'Apocalypse Dragon' last time-"

I know. Of course. But that's not what I was curious about.

"Let me ask again."

"..."

"Where is the 'real Han Sooyoung' right now?"

The real Han Sooyoung.

Lee Seolhwa glared at me with her eyes wide open.

"You..."

I felt a fierce energy for a moment.

Lee Hyunsung, who had finished cleaning up the dead Constellations in the front, was approaching me.

"What's going on?"

Lee Hyunsung's expression was cold as he looked at me, as if he had been watching me the whole time. A threatening fighting spirit flowed out of his body, as if he would rush at me at any moment.

Lee Jihye, who had finished organizing the right front, joined us soon after.

"Ahjussi! I've taken care of this side too! What's going on, why is the atmosphere like this?"

Did she sense the strange air flowing around her? Lee Jihye looked at me and Lee Hyunsung with tense eyes.

Lee Seolhwa sighed deeply and opened her mouth.

"Dokja-ssi wants to meet the 'real' Captain."

Then Lee Hyunsung blocked my path and said.

"The Captain is not feeling well right now."

"It will only take a moment."

"The Captain is not the kind of person you can meet whenever you want."

I compared the Lee Hyunsung of the 1,863rd Round I had read with the Lee Hyunsung in front of me. Lee Hyunsung was originally a person with strong loyalty, but this was too much. However, if I was going to back down here, I wouldn't have even brought it up in the first place.

"What exactly is wrong with her? I might be able to fix it."

Rain fell from the sky. It was so cold that it felt like snow. The raindrops fell directly on me and the group's heads.

I could see Kim Namwoon approaching from afar, stealthily keeping an eye on me.

"Kim Namwoon, take Dokja-ssi inside."

"Huh? Huh?"

Kim Namwoon, surprised by Lee Hyunsung's strong tone, grabbed my arm and pulled me.

"Ahjussi, I don't know what's going on, but let's go inside. Okay, everyone, get out of the way!"

I shook off Kim Namwoon's hand and said.

"Let's get rid of it. How long do you plan on continuing this 'direction'?"

I looked around at the sky and shouted.

"Han Sooyoung! I know you're listening!"

The moment Lee Hyunsung frowned and took a step toward me.

"There are still two left!"

Shin Yoosung shouted while operating the 'Chimera Dragon' in the air.

"Over there, over there!"

Two tall buildings located across from the base. A dreary story was blooming on the top of each building. On the railing of the roof, two incarnations of young women stood precariously, and their appearances were ominous at first glance.

Threateningly long, torn mouths.

The women, who looked as gaunt as zombies, looked at each other and opened their mouths at the same time.

Aaaahhhhhhh—

The first to show an abnormal reaction were the incarnations at the front. With a thud, they dropped their weapons and stared blankly at the sky.

Some of them grabbed their own faces or grabbed their chests.

Aaaahhhhhh—

My heart grew cold. The identity of the 'star dregs' inhabiting those female bodies was clear.

The group in the back, who had come to their senses late, shouted.

"It's a siren!"

A siren. One of the monsters of Greek and Roman mythology.

The stars of the damned <Olympus> had summoned even the monsters that were comparable to Constellations of fairy tales.

"Everyone, cover your ears!"

Even though Lee Seolhwa shouted, most of the incarnations were already entranced by the Siren's song.

I recalled the 'Siren Countermeasure' from 'Ways of Survival' in my head.

「Despite its high notoriety, the 'Siren' countermeasure is very simple. First, cover your ears. If you have the [Sound Blocking] skill, the Siren's song is not a threat at all.」

However, it seemed that there were no incarnations around that could use [Sound Blocking].

「Even if you don't have [Sound Blocking], there's no need to panic. If you have a high-grade [Mental Barrier], you can sufficiently resist the Siren's song heard from a distance.」

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

「Fourth Wall activated as if it had been waiting for it. Fortunately, if you have a high-level mental barrier skill like me, the Siren's story is hardly a threat. The problem was that such advanced skills would not be easily distributed to ordinary incarnations.」

Even with a mental barrier, it was not 100% safe.

「However, there are reports that incarnations with particularly high sensitivity are more sensitive to the Siren's Song.」

The new form of the 'Chimera Dragon' that covered the sky was shaking dangerously. Lee Jihye noticed this and shouted.

"Shin Yoosooung!"

The Chimera Dragon that had been flying in the air suddenly lost its direction and began to fall. The dragon's gigantic body fell to the ground with a loud noise.

"Ah..."

A faint groan could be heard in the thick dust.

"Th-thank you."

Shin Yoosung stuttered as she was held in my arms while I activated [Way of the Wind]. She looked up at me with her eyes wide open in surprise and asked.

"But... I think something similar happened before..."

I put Shin Yoosung down on the ground. Perhaps she remembered Kim Dokja who visited two years ago.

"Please rest."

It was a grateful thing, but right now, dealing with the sirens came first.

There were two sirens on the rooftop of the building.

I quickly checked the status of the group. Right now, excluding me, there were only two people in the group who had resistance to the siren's voice.

One was Lee Hyunsung, the Steel Sword Emoeror. However, Lee Hyunsung was slow. Then.

"Kim Namwoon!"

I shouted at Kim Namwoon.

"Please take care of the siren on the right!"

Kim Namwoon, who suddenly came to his senses, nodded at me.

"Okay, leave it to me!"

As soon as he answered, I started running toward the siren on the rooftop of the building on the left.

Ooooooooh—

The closer the listening distance of the siren's song, the more mental burden on the target increases.

But I wasn't worried.

I had [Fourth Wall], and Kim Namwoon—

"Euhahahaha!"

Even if he didn't listen to that song, he was already crazy.

「The Delusion Demon is resistant to one-dimensional 'mental attacks'.」

His exclusive trait, 'Middle School Syndrome', has probably evolved into 'the Ultimate Delusionist' by now.

"It's nice to listen to!"

To Kim Namwoon, who reinterprets all information in reality with his own 'Delusion Filter', the siren's song posed no threat at all.

Scream!

In an instant, Kim Namwoon climbed the wall and cut off the first siren's neck.

I also activated [Way of the Wind] and reached the second siren's eyes.

The siren's eyes widened. The 'Blade of Faith' scattered its magic power, and the siren, sensing danger, raised her voice for the last time almost at the same time.

Aaaahhhh—

The moment the siren's head hit the ground, the guy's last song engulfed the entire area. Even I, who had [Fourth Wall], felt the illusion that the floor was rippling like water for a moment.

A strong urge to throw myself below deck.

The head of the siren rolling on the floor was laughing.

I reflexively looked back and saw the patients sticking their heads out the windows of the base. As if possessed by something, the patients were hanging on the windows one by one. People who were laughing and giggling stretched their legs toward the empty space. The horrifying scene that would unfold in the next moment was vivid in my eyes.

Falling. All those incarnations will fall at once.

For a moment, I felt time slow down, and my brain circuits accelerated.

"Everyone—"

I activated the skill that I was best at using as the story moved and the probability was charged.

"—Stop!"

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

As if a huge rock had fallen on the water, the entire area was engulfed in a silent spray. I felt Kim Namwoon and the others looking back with surprised faces. And.

"What, what is it?"

"Huh? Huhuhuh—"

"What the hell… what happened?"

The people who had stretched their legs under the railing of the building were screaming and falling down one by one.

"What the heck, ahjussi. If you could have used something like this, you should have used it sooner!"

Kim Namwoon, who had come running while making a thud thud sound, patted my back painfully.

But I couldn't smile back at him.

I slid down the building and ran toward the headquarters. Neither Lee Hyunsung, Lee Seolhwa, nor Lee Jihye stopped me. They knew where I was going.

At the end of my gaze, there was an incarnation that had fallen to the ground.

"Dokja-ssi."

Even though I used [Incite], I couldn't protect everyone. The incarnation that had been entranced by the Siren's song and thrown itself to the ground was there. A man who hit his head on the floor and died.

I stood still and watched the man’s end. It was a character I didn’t know.

"Kim Dokja-ssi."

I heard Lee Hyunsung’s voice calling me, and placed my hand on the dead man’s head. There was no blood flowing anywhere. Only the rampant stories he had been holding lingered like an aftertaste.

I felt Lee Hyunsung’s strong grip on my shoulder.

"Calm down."

I slowly got up from my seat and looked back at Lee Hyunsung. Lee Hyunsung added with a blunt face.

"No one is dead."

"No one is dead?"

"Yes."

With those words, the dead man’s incarnation body magically disappeared. And the next moment, someone opened the main gate of the headquarters and appeared.

"Haam… Heeeeek! Th, what is this! What happened?"

The man who was making a fuss while wearing a torn hospital gown was the man who had just disappeared before my eyes.

I stared at the man with a blank expression, then slowly opened my mouth.

"I see. No one died."

I felt like laughing.

Despite the fierce battle against such powerful enemies, not a single person died.

「That's how Han Sooyoung created 'the one and only perfect world'.」

A world where no one can see the end without dying.

I couldn't figure out whether Han Sooyoung, who created this world, had gone crazy, or whether the <Star Stream>, which had encouraged Han Sooyoung to create this world, had gone crazy, or whether I was crazy for accepting this world as crazy.

Since I couldn't figure it out, I laughed like a crazy person. I laughed alone in a scenery where no one was laughing. Then, I suddenly stopped laughing and said,

"But it seems like no one is alive."

I couldn't believe those words came out of my mouth.

Do Avatars exist?

Isn't it? If the avatar commits suicide, is it suicide or not? If the avatar dies, is it death or not?

The avatar, I.

"Kim Dokja. You are not a human in this world."

The moment I thought about it that far, I thought I knew why I was so angry.

"Whatever happens here is none of your business."

"Lee Hyunsung, is that your idea? Or..."

Watching Lee Hyunsung slowly clenching his fist, I bit my lip as I asked.

"Is it the idea of 'Han Sooyoung' who created you?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 888 Episode 48 Avatar (11)

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I saw Lee Hyunsung's shoulders flinch at my words.

He must be angry. I know that those words might make him feel bad.

Nevertheless, it was something that had to be said.

"I will solve the 'problem' of this worldline."

Because that was the 'scenario' I had received.

The problem of the worldline.

The moment I saw the story that Lee Hyunsung was telling, I could instinctively know. The secret they were hiding was the 'problem' I was looking for.

And in order to dig up that problem, I needed to dig into their sensitive parts as much as possible.

"What do you know?"

A lofty wave of story rose from Lee Hyunsung's entire body. When I directly faced his story that defeated the 'star dregs', the pressure was truly enormous. This was the power of the Steel Sword Emperor who had reached the Final Scenario.

If I were to fight one-on-one right now, would I be able to defeat Lee Hyunsung?

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', growls.]

If we only consider my specs, I'm not that disadvantaged. I have a Mythical Story, and a 'Giant Tale' that has yet to be named.

But I wasn't sure. It wasn't simply because Lee Hyunsung's story was so powerful.

I don't know why, but the moment I confronted his anger, I felt as if I was encountering a world. I felt the emotions of that world so clearly that I could touch them. A world that was strong, noble, sad, and for some reason, resented me.

This world...

"I understand."

As soon as Lee Seolhwa stopped me, the pressure of the story that had been weighing me disappeared as if it had been washed away.

"I'll take you to the Captain."

"Seolhwa-ssi."

Lee Seolhwa nodded to Lee Hyunsung as if telling him to stay still. Lee Hyunsung, who had been biting his lips nervously, quickly stepped aside.

"Follow me."

I followed Lee Seolhwa to the base. We walked along the path where the rain was falling steadily. Even though it was a path that would take only 10 seconds to reach if we ran, Lee Seolhwa's pace was leisurely. It was as if she was deliberately killing time.

"How have you been over the past two years?"

I wondered if she was asking to lighten the mood.

I smiled and asked back.

"Isn't it too late to ask me?"

"I'm sorry."

Looking at Lee Seolhwa smiling brightly, I thought for a moment about what to say.

First of all, I wasn't 'Kim Dokja who visited here two years ago'.

So what should I say as Kim Dokja's representative?

I've had a lot going on. I've seen the end of the scenarios, I've become a god of the universe, and then my existence was torn to pieces, and now I stand before you as one of those torn pieces. There is… I can express all that history, but I barely managed to find a sentence that can explain nothing.

"There was a lot going on."

"We are like that too."

I nodded to Lee Seolhwa's words.

"Yes, it seems so."

Lee Seolhwa's steps slowed down even more.

Now the base was right in front of us.

"Have you had a separate conversation with the Captain?"

"She asked me to watch the end of this world together."

Lee Seolhwa paused for a moment at my words.

"The Captain has been waiting for you all along."

"Me?"

"Too long."

Waited too long?

Lee Seolhwa stood tall at the entrance of the base. Her gaze, blankly staring at the entrance, was somewhat lonely.

"I'll ask you one last time. Do you really want to meet the 'real Han Sooyoung'?"

I let out a light sigh.

"I don't know why you keep wasting time. Aren't you a part of Han Sooyoung anyway?"

"…"

“Lee Hyunsung, Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye. Everyone already knows that they are Han Sooyoung's avatars."

I had seen Han Sooyoung recreate <Kim Dokja Company> with her avatars before.

But Han Sooyoung of the 1,863rd Round could do even more.

In short, she could inject all the avatars with different stories and make them into one 'being'.

"Stop acting, Han Sooyoung."

"I know what you're thinking, but I'm not Han Sooyoung."

"You're Han Sooyoung's avatar."

Lee Seolhwa's eyebrows furrowed at my assertion.

"Yes, that's right. I am her avatar."

At the same time as Lee Seolhwa answered, a light spark flew from the entrance of the base.

I observed the spark for a moment, then looked around at the surrounding incarnations and asked.

"Is there anyone here who is not an avatar?"

I thought that there was no way that they were all [Avatars].

Even if it was Han Sooyoung, would it be possible to operate this many avatars simultaneously?

Instead of asking, I could have checked it myself. After all, avatars have the characteristic of 'bleeding stories, not blood'.

However, not all avatars are like that, and avatars that have received a certain amount of memories bleed.

In other words, with my current abilities, there was no way to distinguish who was an avatar and who was not.

"Is that important?"

"It is important. I need to know why Han Sooyoung did this."

"What are you going to do when you find out?"

"Yes?"

"If you find out why the Captain recreated us as avatars, will you take responsibility for this world with the Captain?"

I couldn't answer.

"Why did Han Sooyoung make you avatars?"

"Just because you're Kim Dokja's avatar, doesn't mean you understand everything about Kim Dokja."

"You don't know?"

"Well, I don't know."

"Please call Han Sooyoung's true body. She can manifest through you whenever she wants."

"It's not that simple. We're not simple [Avatars]."

You're not simple [Avatars]?

"Do you really want to know the truth of this world? The Captain doesn't want you to know."

Lee Seolhwa's voice was earnest as she said those words.

"You can just pretend not to know and stay in this world. If the Captain hid something, there must be a reason for it."

I shook my head.

"That's not my way."

"Some secrets make you responsible just by knowing them. Are you still curious?"

I nodded.

Lee Seolhwa took a deep breath and said.

"From now on, get your mind straight. This 'base' is not where you thought it was."

With those words, Lee Seolhwa grabbed my wrist.

"Don't believe what you see in front of you. Don't be fooled by the sentence right in front of you. Believe the 'story' you think, the 'story' you believe."

Before I could even ask what that meant, my vision was enveloped in darkness. I wondered what was going on.

"Seolhwa-ssi?"

I spoke to Lee Seolhwa. Lee Seolhwa's hand appeared in the dim light floating in the air. Lee Seolhwa's body had completely disappeared, leaving only the wrist that was holding me.

I flinched and stepped back, seeing the blood dripping on the floor. I instinctively thought that I had to get out of here. However, the moment I looked back, I couldn't see the entrance I had just entered.

"Seolhwa-ssi!"

The voice echoed hollowly in the darkness.

A moment later, a voice was heard in the darkness.

"Save me."

It was Lee Seolhwa's voice.

"Save me."

At the same time, a piece of advice came to mind.

Don't believe what you see before your eyes.

"Please save me."

I felt something grabbing my ankle. I saw hands filling the floor. Hands crawling like insects were holding my ankle.

"Please save me."

I gradually became unable to tell whose voice it was. Nevertheless, I knew the owners of those wrists.

"Pleasesavemepleasesavemepleasesavemepleasesavemepleasesavemepleasesavemeplease asesavemepleasesaveme."

Some wrists belonged to Kim Namwoon, and some belonged to Lee Jihye. There were also wrists that looked like those of an Archangel or a Demon King.

I felt like I would go crazy if I stayed still, so I started running. And the next moment.

"Avoid!"

A huge magic wave flew from the front. I felt someone covering my body as if covering it.

A large man looked down at me.

"Lee Hyunsung?"

Lee Hyunsung, who had raised his body while protecting me, dripped blood from his mouth. The blood he had been possessed flowed into the large hole in his chest.

"I'm sorry, Captain."

Lee Hyunsung's head burst open.

When I reached out, Lee Hyunsung's body turned into stories and scattered.

And the sentence before my eyes came to mind.

「Scenario 85. Hypothesis 9724. 'Demon World Hell Island' discarded.」

The scene before my eyes changed.

All I could see was the vast ocean.

I heard something exploding in the distance. The tsunami of the ocean was coming.

"Eeeeeeeee! I can't stand it anymore!"

"I told you not to touch Poseidon!"

The voices that resembled Lee Jihye and Kim Namwoon crashed like waves, and soon everything in front of me was swept away by the sea.

「Scenario 44. Hypothesis 981. 'Sea Expedition' discarded.」

With no time to catch my breath, the scene changed once again.

"What the hell is that?"

When I raised my head, I saw a huge meteorite falling. Beyond the meteorite, the Constellations were grinning. And the voices of the incarnations despairing.

"How can I deal with something like that—"

Then the Earth was shattered into pieces.

「Scenario 72. Hypothesis 9135. 'Interstellar Road Murder' discarded.」

I couldn't come to my senses from the tragedy that was raging.

Why on earth are these things inside the base?

Every time I took a deep breath, the pain and screams of the dying incarnations flowed into me.

The pain felt like my head was going to burst. Inside, I muttered.

"I am Kim Dokja."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

I protected my mind with the strengthened [Fourth Wall].

Even in the midst of all this, the scenery before my eyes continued to change.

「Scenario 88. Hypothesis 9135. 'Deep Sea Monarch' discarded.」

A monster that awoke from the deep sea attacked the Korean Peninsula.

「Scenario 89. Hypothesis 331. 'Zeus Provocation' discarded.」

Ignoring the probability, <First Murim> collapsed due to the strong Zeus.

「Scenario 90. Hypothesis 9135. 'Otherworldly Deity #61' discarded.」

All of humanity died after accidentally summoning the 'Otherworldly Deity' to fight against the Giant Nebula.

「Scenario 90. Hypothesis 911. 'Nebula Spy' discarded.」

They planned to overthrow the Giant Nebula from within, but instead she was captured and subjected to terrible torture.

It was strange.

If all of these are Han Sooyoung's memories, then why do these memories exist?

Isn't she Yoo Joonghyuk?

「It's not only those who regress that regress.」

For a moment, I vaguely thought I knew the answer.

This was a 'regression' that only she could do.

「Scenario 90. Hypothesis 12454, 'Black Cloud Killing' discarded.」

「Scenario 91. Hypothesis 1199. 'Invasion of Olympus' discarded.」

…

As I watched the vivid destruction pouring down before my eyes, I thought about the origin of all this destruction.

These records were all records of 'worlds that could have existed'. All of this destruction had occurred entirely within her.

「Predictive Plagiarism.」

'Future Prediction Stigmata' surpassing Hermes's 'Big Data System' or Anna Croft's [Future Sight].

I knew that if such an ability was activated, the user would certainly pay a huge price, but I never thought that the way the stigma was implemented would be like this.

「Scenario 92. Hypothesis 10841. 'The Nameless Mist' discarded.」

I had completely overlooked how vivid a representation was needed to measure the future with a mere 'thought experiment'.

A fantasy world where you can't feel even the slightest difference from reality. Sitting in the twisted tunnel of her mind, Han Sooyoung wrote and erased countless worlds to protect just one reality.

「Scenario 92. Hypothesis 12841. 'Nirvana Re-entry' discarded.」

She wrote characters dying in front of her eyes over and over again. She wrote, erased, wrote, and erased.

I couldn't know how her mind had changed during that time. I couldn't know what it was like to live a life sacrificing countless fictional stories to complete just one story.

「This 'hypothetical world' doesn't exist.」

The writer, leaning on that one psychological breakwater, endlessly destroyed, destroyed, and destroyed the world again.

One day, she might have thought this.

「Is this hypothesis really a 'hypothesis'?」

How is this secret country that remains in her memory different from the 1,863 regressions that Yoo Joonghyuk has lived through? How is it different from the 'Ways of Survival' that was once a novel?

「Scenario 93. Hypothesis 12841. 'Hermes Hacking' discarded.」

「Scenario 93. Hypothesis 31145. 'Isgard End' discarded.」

「Scenario 94. Hypothesis 1912. 'Korean Peninsula Unification' discarded.」

「Scenario 94. Hypothesis 8754. 'Worldline Overturning' discarded.」

My breathing became more and more suffocated.

I wanted to know what had driven her this far.

At the end of this false ending, I wanted to ask what the real ending she had been looking for was.

At that moment...

「Scenario 95.」

A landscape unfolded. It was a landscape where destruction had not yet come.

「'The Second Coming of the Apocalypse.'」

A rooftop of a base where a cool night breeze blew. A man was standing on the edge of that rooftop. The moment I saw his fluttering white coat, I realized.

This was not a 'hypothesis.'

"Han Sooyoung."

The Kim Dokja I remember.

The Kim Dokja who had crossed the worldline like me and visited the 1,863rd Round that day was speaking.

"What kind of story do you want to write in the future?"

Han Sooyoung asked back.

"What kind of story do you want to read?"

Kim Dokja seemed to think for a moment.

As I watched Kim Dokja, surrounded by the desolate night scenery, I suddenly thought I knew what he was going to say. Perhaps there was no sin in that answer. Nevertheless,

"I wish there was a story where no one dies."

Kim Dokja should not have given that answer.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 889 Episode 48 Avatar (12)

My fingertips trembled violently.

I wondered if that was true.

Maybe the reason Han Sooyoung created so many avatars was…

「Scenario 95. 'The Reincarnation of the Apocalypse'.」

The screen changed, and the scenario began to play out in real time before my eyes.

"Captain, will we be okay?"

The sound of the sealing ball in the sky moving was heard along with Kim Namwoon's worried voice.

It would take three days for the seal to be completely released.

「"The Apocalypse is not over just because it's been released. You know that, right?"」

Han Sooyoung agreed with Kim Dokja.

"I'll tell you in advance, there's no way for us to fight the Apocalypse head-on and win."

The Apocalypse that was coming this time was the disaster that destroyed <Eden> in the past Holy Demon War. There was no way that human power could stop the disaster that even destroyed the Giant Nebula.

"But there is a way for everyone to survive."

Han Sooyoung said as he looked around at her party.

"We just have to abandon Earth."

'The Resurrection of the Apocalypse' is a scenario whose goal is to liberate the Apocalypse.

They could survive if they moved to the next scenario area before the creature woke up.

Is that all?

Now that they had liberated the Apocalypse, they could also receive a reward.

The Giant Tale, 「Liberator of the Apocalypse」.

It was truly an enormous reward.

They would probably be able to meet most of the conditions needed for the 'introduction, development, climax, and conclusion' with the 'Giant Tale' they obtained this time. And in the Last Scenario, they would be able to compete with the Giant Nebulae.

But they had to discard the cards they needed to discard for that.

"Don't worry, I'll take all of my colleagues from headquarters with me."

The colleagues looked half in doubt. Lee Jihye was the first to raise an objection.

"Captain. Even if we move, not everyone else can go."

"What about the Constellations on the Korean Peninsula?"

Lee Hyunsung also nodded and added.

Unlike Han Sooyoung, who became a Constellation herself, all of her colleagues had contracts with a sponsor. Even if the incarnations move on to the next scenario, their sponsor is in a different situation.

"The Maritime War God and the God of Wine and Ecstasy are all from the Earth as the origin of the legend. If the Earth disappears because of the Apocalypse Dragon..."

The Constellations that lost the origin of their legend could face the risk of extinction.

That wasn't the only problem.

"There are also people who didn't receive this main scenario."

Including the craftsmen, those who couldn't move on to the 'next scenario area'.

"Captain, we're fine."

"Thank you for leading us this far."

The incarnations who couldn't participate in the Apocalypse Dragon Liberation battle because they didn't meet the qualifications for the scenario.

If the party moves on like this, all the remaining ones will be abandoned. And if they're unlucky, they'll be swept away by the destruction of the Earth and scattered as story fragments.

Han Sooyoung bit her lip.

She couldn't save everyone. 「Predictive Plagiarism」 wasn't omnipotent, she knew that well.

But even though she knew that well, why was she so troubled?

「"I wish there was a story where no one dies."」

Is it because she heard that from Kim Dokja?

「Scenario 95, hypothesis 1575 'Apocalypse Dragon Resealing' discarded.」

「Scenario 95, hypothesis 5612 'Righteous talent' discarded.」

Han Sooyoung thought and thought again.

「Scenario 95, hypothesis 9413 'Sealing Orb Reinforcement' discarded.」

「Scenario 95, hypothesis 18563 'Jophiel' discarded.」

…

She destroyed countless worlds inside her in real time, searching for a method and finding it again.

The result.

「Scenario 95, hypothesis 88875 'Grand Banquet'.」

She arrived at a hypothesis.

「Success rate less than 30%.」

A hypothesis is only a hypothesis when it's in your head. The moment even one sentence of that hypothesis comes out of your head, it becomes reality.

「If it fails, all the main characters will be annihilated.」

A failed plan will lead to the end of reality. A writer who knows that well should never have mentioned this plan out loud.

Still.

"Just one."

Han Sooyoung opened her mouth after a long silence.

"If there's a way to defeat the Apocalypse and protect the Earth... will you try it?"

If it were the usual Han Sooyoung, she wouldn't have brought that up to the group.

A plan that takes that much risk can't be called a 'plan'.

But Han Sooyoung was different that day.

"If it fails, everyone could die."

She took her time explaining the plan. She paid extra attention when explaining the level of risk. She explained and explained for a long time that they didn’t have to make this choice, that they were walking into the pit of hell instead of the safe path.

The group listened carefully to Han Sooyoung.

And when the story finally ended, Lee Jihye asked.

"Why didn’t you tell me about that method earlier?"

For some reason, the group looked delighted. Even though the plan had less than a 30% success rate, and even though it was a plan that could easily wipe out everyone here, the expressions on the group’s faces after hearing the story were strangely bright.

"I waited for the Captain to say that."

"We can now fight properly."

Looking at the faces of the group, Han Sooyoung also realized something a little late.

She wasn’t the only one who was inspired by Kim Dokja—or by the story he left behind.

"A 30% success rate is a very high success rate. And Captain, you can’t execute that plan alone, right?"

The plan was established.

But not long after that, Han Sooyoung began to think.

「That plan had to be a 'hypothesis'.」

The moment I unconsciously held my breath, the scene changed once again.

When I blinked, the first thing I saw was the gorgeous chandelier hanging from the ceiling.

I was standing in a banquet hall.

As I stood there blankly, several incarnations of the Constellations came and bumped into me. As I lost my balance and stumbled, someone grabbed my hand.

"I told you to come to your senses."

It was Lee Seolhwa.

With music flowing from somewhere, Lee Seolhwa naturally grabbed both of my hands. We started dancing together.

I answered, moving my feet to the beat.

"I’m sorry."

"If you don't read the story properly, the story will read you."

I nodded and took a deep breath.

"What is this banquet hall?"

As I looked around, I noticed some familiar faces.

It wasn't just Lee Seolhwa. Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, and Kim Namwoon were each taking up a table in the banquet hall.

There were also incarnations from overseas. China's Fei Hu, India's Ranbir Khan, Japan's Asuka Ren.

Next to them were the incarnations of the Constellations. The Maritime War God, the Bald General of Justice, the First Sword of Goryeo, and the King of Beauty.

There were also incarnations of the Constellations of the Giant Nebula, the incarnations of the Constellations of the Narrative or Myth-grade.

The overwhelming feeling of the stars was so great that the wide hall felt cramped.

Lee Seolhwa, who had seen them with me, asked.

"You said you wanted to know the truth of the world, right?"

Lee Seolhwa said with a slightly sad smile.

"Then look straight ahead."

To the podium in the center of the hall I saw Han Sooyoung come up.

"Thank you all for gathering."

Han Sooyoung, who was standing on the podium, opened her mouth.

「Scenario 95. Hypothesis 88875 'Grand Banquet' execution.」

It had been a while since I had heard such eloquence. It was a speech that was neat and tidy, but emphasized the necessary parts appropriately. Anyone with ears could not help but be moved.

The content of the speech was simple.

「Let's create a 'Single Tale' that all Constellations share.」

When the speech was finally over, there was a great reaction in the banquet hall.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', shares the same intentions as 'Director of the False Ending'.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', nods and cheers.]

[The Constellation, 'Goryeo's First Sword', agrees with 'Director of the False Ending'.]

…

However, not all the Constellations were friendly to her.

[The Constellation, 'Ferocious Lord', asks if you called him to tell him something ridiculous.]

[The Demon King claims that the 'Black Maned Lion' is just nonsense that doesn't need to be heard anymore.]

[The Constellation, 'Almighty Sun', shakes his head.]

[The Constellations of the Nebula, <Asgard>, prepares to leave.]

Han Sooyoung coldly warned those Constellations.

"If you run away like that now, there's no turning back."

[Some Constellations laugh at the words of the 'Director of the False Ending.']

[A small number of Myth-grade Constellations say that they don't need to take such risks.]

"Yes, you Myth-grade Constellations would be like that. But what about the guys below you? What about the Constellations that didn't make it to the Final Scenario? When the Apocalypse starts to twitch its tail, all of these children will die."

[Some Constellations ask if that's true.]

[A few Myth-grade Constellations are silent.]

"We haven't tried it."

The solution to some scenarios is very simple. However, since the solution is so simple that anyone can think of it, no one thinks of it as the solution.

"Never before have all the Constellations faced a single disaster."

Han Sooyoung's plan was clear.

The Apocalypse starts to 'twitch its tail' as soon as it is resurrected. If only the Apocalypse's 'resurrection disaster' could be prevented, the Constellations would have a chance.

"It's possible. You all know that. There is no 'truly impossible' scenario in this <Star Stream>."

The Constellations were shaken by her words.

Han Sooyoung continued.

"It's possible if everyone dreams of the same story. If everyone wants the same scenario, it's quite possible. Because—"

After a short pause, Han Sooyoung finished her words.

"You are the <Star Stream>."

If Han Sooyoung, who didn't trust the Constellations, had been her usual self, she would never have carried out that plan.

「To hold a single 'Grand Banquet' and unite the Constellations.」

Even so, the reason Han Sooyoung adopted the plan was probably because the Constellations who changed her mind were also Constellations.

[The Constellations of the nebula, <Olympus>, prepares to leave the scenario.]

However, the Constellations had lived too long to be persuaded by a brief speech. Their choice had been predetermined.

[The Constellations of the nebula, <Vedas>, prepares to leave the scenario.]

Faced with the catastrophe before her eyes, Han Sooyoung smiled as if she had expected that.

"Yeah, I knew it. But you don't have a choice anyway, do you?"

[From now on, 'Scenario departures' are restricted.]

"Because."

[Warning! The resurrection of the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse' is imminent!]

In order to gather the Constellations together and borrow their power, Han Sooyoung made a drastic choice.

"The disaster has already begun."

「That is, to bring forward the 'Resurrection of the Apocalypse' by a few hours earlier than scheduled.」

A loud noise echoed through the sky. The entire banquet hall seemed to shake dangerously, and the Apocalypse Dragon began to poke its head out through the broken seal.

"From now on, we will create the Final Tale of the <Star Stream>."

Han Sooyoung's plan was perfect.

Attracting the Constellations and making them all fight against the 'Apocalypse Dragon' at the same time.

But as always, a perfect plan did not necessarily guarantee success.

「Scenario 95, 'The Second Coming of the Apocalypse Dragon'.」

That day when the night sky of the <Star Stream> was brightly lit by a director.

「Failure of the scenario strategy.」

The universe of the 1,863rd Round returned to the darkness of the beginning.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 890 Episode 48 Avatar (13)

A meteor shower was observed.

A rain of stars falling from the sky.

I realized anew how many Constellations there were in the sky of the <Star Stream>.

The Constellations that forced the scenarios on the incarnations, cheered them, laughed at them, mocked them, supported them, saved them, and were saved.

The Constellations were weighing.

I looked up at the scenery she had seen that day in Han Sooyoung's world.

"It begins."

Everything flowed according to Han Sooyoung's will. The Constellations that were blocked from running away from her scheme had no choice but to follow Han Sooyoung's plan.

「First Wave, Lightning.」

One of the representative Constellations of <Asgard> stood against the Lightning Wave.

[I am the Thunder of Thursday!]

Thunder of Thursday, Thor.

[I didn't know I would end up fighting you.]

Indra, the God King of Lightning.

The Constellations of the Narrative-grade that belonged to the Ten-Yo also participated.

[Ooooooooooo!]

'Lightning of Disaster and Harvest', Raijin.

A Japanese Constellation that did not properly appear in the main story.

Kugugugugu!

But those three could not cancel out all the lightning waves.

[We'll join in too!]

The martial artists who learned the martial arts of the electric power system, and the Constellations of the great men also helped.

But despite the cooperation of those Constellations, the lightning wave that spread out mercilessly swept away the universe of the <Star Stream>.

The Constellations were oxidized without even being able to scream.

But there was no time to look back at them.

「Second wave, Flames.」

The flame wave continued without giving them a moment to catch their breath. The Constellations began to retreat in fear at the flame wave that was even larger than the lightning wave.

"Now it's my turn to step forward!"

As Kim Namwoon, who was covered in [Black Flame] all over his body, confidently stepped forward, the Constellations also burst into cheers as if they could not lose.

[Nothing compared to the flames of the volcano!]

The Blacksmith of the Volcano, Hephaestus.

[It is time to choose the strongest flame.]

'Burning Tragedy', Kagutsuchi and 'Wandering Lantern', Jack O'Lantern.

What appeared behind them was the God of Fire whose entire body was engulfed in bright flames.

[I will stop it.]

Agni, the 'Flame of Purification', one of the Locapalas of <Vedas>.

[This time, I cannot miss out.]

Likewise, Surua, the 'God of Supreme Light', one of the Locapalas.

[K, I am pushed back—!]

[Kuaaaaaaaah!]

Even so, the total amount of power was insufficient. As the Constellations became stronger, the shockwaves emitted by the Apocalypse Dragon also became stronger. The moment Hephaestus and Agni, who had been holding out in the front row, were scattered to ashes, the terrified Constellations screamed and ran away.

However, there were some Constellations that did not run away and kept their positions.

[Not yet.]

She was the last remaining Archangel of the 1,863rd <Eden>.

The Demon-like Judge of Fire, Uriel.

The wall of flames built around her blocked the heat wave. How much time had passed like that? Uriel's [Hellfire] began to split the waves of heat little by little.

A disaster that confirmed the destruction of the <Star Stream> along with its manifestation. The Constellations trembled as they watched the disaster being canceled out in real time before their eyes.

[Yes, we did it. We did it!]

[This could really be…!]

Although the damage to the planets other than Earth was enormous, the Constellations that protected the main scenario area regained their spirits.

However, Han Sooyoung's expression was not so bright.

「The flow is not good.」

The scenery in front of me was a scene from a hypothesis that had already been discarded.

「Discarded hypothesis 87413. 'Sabotage'.」

In that hypothesis, the lightning and flame waves of the Apocalypse Dragon were blocked much more easily than expected, and as a result, the Star Stream met a terrible end.

[The <Star Stream>'s probability is moving.]

Han Sooyoung bit her lips.

[What, why is the probability suddenly—]

[Damn it! That's…!]

The <Star Stream>'s probability flows in the direction that the watching Constellations want.

Even in this situation where countless Constellations were facing off against the Apocalypse Dragon, there were still Constellations enjoying the game.

[Why are the Myth-grade Constellations…]

The Myth-grade Constellations had already sacrificed their own legends and escaped the disaster zone.

They were watching the destruction of Earth in the Final Scenario zone.

[The <Star Stream>'s Myth-grade Constellations laugh at the 'Director of the False Ending'.]

They did not want Han Sooyoung and other Constellations to prevent the disaster of the Apocalypse Dragon. If such a 'Tale' were born, Han Sooyoung would have the power to destroy even the positions of the Myth-grade Constellations.

「Third Wave, Chaos.」

The third wave of the Apocalypse Dragon then attacked the Constellations.

[Ahhhhhh!]

The Constellations that were hit by the chaos wave from the front collapsed with a final gasp.

The chaos wave was fundamentally different from the previous lightning wave or flame wave. Only beings with both good and evil characteristics or those who were protected by a 'divinity of the other world' could deal with it. However, this was not without a way to attack. If the Constellations of 'Absolute Good' and 'Absolute Evil' that participated in the Holy Demon War joined forces, and thus could recreate the grand tale of the 'Holy Demon War', it would be possible to arbitrarily implement the attribute of chaos.

However.

[Some Constellations are protected by the 'Nebula' and depart from the scenario!]

Taking advantage of the weakened regulation of the scenario, the Constellations of 'Absolute Good' and 'Absolute Evil' that were protected by the Holy Gate began to depart one by one.

In an instant, only one Constellation of the Holy War remained in the front.

"Uriel! No!"

The incarnation of the Archangel who had thrown everything away along with the flames of [Hellfire] was scattered to ashes.

The balance of the battlefield collapsed, and the Historical-grade Constellations trembled in fear. Everything in the area was being swept away by the chaos wave of the Apocalypse Dragon.

However, Han Sooyoung did not give up.

"I expected this."

Gazing upon the approaching chaos wave, Han Sooyoung took out the Holy Fruit of <Eden> from her bosom. The moment she bit into the 'Fruit of the Tree of Good and Evil', the power of chaos surged from her entire body.

[The power of the 'Fruit of the Tree of Good and Evil' seeps into you!]

[All the Constellations of 'Absolute Good' are astonished by your choice!]

[All the Constellations of 'Absolute Evil' are astonished by your choice!]

[Some Myth-grade Constellations mock you, saying that it is impossible for you to endure the 'Chaos Wave' alone.]

Han Sooyoung also knew.

Eating the Fruit of the Tree of Good and Evil was just a means to use her body as a conduit for 'chaos'.

In order to prevent the approaching disaster, she needed the support of a powerful being that could restrain the Apocalypse Dragon.

The first thing that came to mind was 'Nameless Mist'. However, if she were to summon the 'Nameless Mist', a disaster like the Apocalypse Dragon, the Earth would also be destroyed in return. The worries didn't last long.

"Great ancient being who governs the ancient tales!"

Chaos rings began to rise all over Han Sooyoung's body.

[Nebula, <Papyrus>, warns you!]

[Nebula, <Olympus>, gives orders to the terminal incarnation!]

[Nebula, <Asgard>, is glaring at you!]

Nebula's terminal incarnations rushed toward Han Sooyoung all at once. They were determined to stop Han Sooyoung even at the risk of self-destruction.

This was what the 1,863rd Myth-grade Constellations thought. If they didn't eliminate Han Sooyoung here, Han Sooyoung would become their greatest threat in the future.

The chaos faction was in front, and the incarnations of Nebulae were running from behind.

Even so, Han Sooyoung was smiling.

"I knew it all."

This was the last tale of the <Star Stream> that she had planned.

「Hypothesis 88876. 'Great Chaos'.」

The chaos wave of the Apocalypse covered the Earth.

[The protection of the 'Great Old Being' is upon you.]

While no Constellation dared to utter a word, the chaos wave of the Apocalypse began to be sucked into her hand.

However, even with the power of the 'Great Old Being', it was impossible to completely handle the chaos wave. So instead of accepting the chaos wave, she chose to twist the chaos wave's trajectory and strike it back.

In the direction she twisted the chaos wave's trajectory.

[The Myth-grade Constellations are astonished!]

The 'Myth-grade Constellations' of the Last Scenario were staying there.

Kugugugugugu!

The Constellations screamed. With countless mantras covering the sky, the chaos wave of the Apocalypse covered the Constellations.

[The Myth-grade Constellations aboard the 'Last Ark' roar!]

The sky was covered in pitch-black darkness. The universe flickered, and day and night alternated.

The shining Constellations began to fade, and the number of indirect messages began to decrease one by one. Thick darkness descended, and the universe was covered in silence.

After a while, when even that darkness receded, Han Sooyoung slowly opened her eyes.

What she saw in the sky was the Apocalypse Dragon, crouching back into the seal as if tired, and the 'Last Ark', torn in half and stuck in the atmosphere.

[All the Constellations of the <Star Stream> will never forget the 'Director of the False Ending'.]

The scenario was over.

She blocked the shockwave of the Apocalypse Dragon.

"It's done."

She barely managed to let out a sigh.

The disaster was over. The hypothesis was successful. But when Han Sooyoung slowly turned her head and looked, a landscape that wasn't in her 「Predictive Plagiarism」 was unfolding.

"Ah."

The characters she had to protect were lying helplessly there.

「Hypothesis 88876. 'Great Chaos'.」

Lee Hyunsung, Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye, Lee Seolhwa, Shin Yoosung. And…

「Failure of development.」

The landscape began to tear apart in front of her eyes. As if erasing a sentence that was written incorrectly, the landscape was blurring mercilessly and quickly.

「That had to be a hypothesis.」

Only sentences that were not erased lingered between the torn landscape.

「It was a story that shouldn't become reality.」

I stared blankly at those sentences.

「That guy probably didn't want to see this kind of story.」

Han Sooyoung's voice and system messages were heard occasionally. Han Sooyoung was carrying her fallen comrades in the torn landscape. Fatal injury that could not be revived even with a Life and Death Ring.

「No one should die.」

Her 「Predicitve Plagiarism」 was going wild. The slurry that flowed out engulfed the group.

The power of the other world began to swallow everything in the area. The dead people and the broken headquarters were covered.

And now I was finally realizing how the scenery I had seen had been created.

That's right. The people I had met, the base in Gwanghwamun, all of it was Han Sooyoung's—

"Kim Dokja-ssi."

When I suddenly turned my head, Lee Soohwa was grabbing my wrist.

"We have to go back now."

"I haven't met the real Han Sooyoung yet."

"The Captain doesn't want to meet you. Because..."

"Because I know the whole truth."

Seeing Lee Soohwa hesitate, I added.

"That's why we have to meet even more."

"Sooyoung-ssi—"

"Han Sooyoung should no longer use [Avatar]."

I know what Lee Seolhwa is trying to say.

The ability to cover Gwanghwamun with her [Avatars]. This was not a miracle of the scale that an ordinary Constellation could perform.

Han Sooyoung may have become a being beyond human. She may have been imbued with the power of the 'Great Old Being' she made a contract with, and become a god.

"There is something I absolutely must say."

Even so, I could not give up.

"Don't be greedy."

"..."

"It was the Captain's choice. She created this world, she made us avatars, it was all the Captain's choice. It's not for you to meddle in it."

"..."

"You just have to pretend not to know. Just experience this world the Captain created, and return to your original world like a reader who reads an interesting story. Then—"

I shook off her hand and started to move forward.

"Kim Dokja!"

Lee Seolhwa's voice grew distant, and my vision was covered in darkness again. With every step I took, the darkness rippled noisily.

I soon realized that the darkness was not simply the absence of light.

「Failure.」

「I failed.」

「This story failed.」

This darkness was the remains of her 「Predictive Plagiarism」.

I called Han Sooyoung's name.

"Han Sooyoung!"

Discarded hypotheses. Discarded memories feebly caught my feet.

At the end of the remains was an old door.

I read the small sign on the door.

'Writing'.

The moment I raised my hand to knock on the door, the darkness that jumped out from behind grabbed me. As if telling me not to disturb her, the pitch-black sentences pulled my hands and feet as if they were restraining them. Soon, my hands and feet, caught in the darkness, turned pitch-black. It started to get wet.

"Han Sooyoung!"

Instead of answering, the sound of the keyboard was constantly coming from behind the door. The fact that I could hear this sound meant that Han Sooyoung was also hearing my voice.

"Kim Dokja has already read your story!"

I had to make her open that door herself and come out.

"The story you wrote saved Kim Dokja!"

Perhaps my words could twist the foundation of the universe. I might be driving the universe to destruction once again in order to save one person in front of me.

「I don't know why she is so obsessed with 'readers'.」

However, I thought about Han Sooyoung's life.

「Maybe that's the setting she received as a 'writer'.」

I thought about the countless sentences she had written and erased, and the distant eternity of writing that spread out before her.

「She deserves to know the truth of this world. Just like Yoo Joonghyuk did.」

I thought of the writer who devoted her life to saving just one person, and of the one reader who read that story again. I thought of the two people who never met each other but saved each other. Maybe that salvation is enough. Maybe that world doesn't need a side story.

Still, wouldn't it be okay to allow them just one sentence? Even if it's just a footnote, even if that footnote changes everything in this world.

"You are tls123."

The keyboard stopped clicking.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 891 Episode 49 tls123 (1)

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「Do you think there is anything more lonely than knowing the future?」

—Anna Croft, the Prophet.

---

If asked to choose a scene from her childhood that could be the introduction to a novel, Han Sooyoung couldn’t help but think of that scene.

"Wake up."

The one who said those words was the 'uncle' who took care of the young Han Sooyoung.

The young Han Sooyoung was the only one who called him uncle. Her father called him a 'manager' and her mother called him a 'housekeeper'.

"No one will protect you."

He made Han Sooyoung’s breakfast at 8 a.m. He was such a good cook that Han Sooyoung never missed a single breakfast he made.

"Is this your country’s food?"

"It’s similar."

Han Sooyoung asked, looking back and forth between the pad thai and banh mi he had made.

"Pad Thai is Thai food, right?"

"That's right."

"Banh Mi is Vietnamese food."

"That's right."

Han Sooyoung didn't ask any more questions. She wouldn't know just by looking at it. Maybe her uncle's mother is Thai and his father is Vietnamese.

Just like her mother is a teacher and her father is a member of the National Assembly.

Her uncle also had a peculiar habit. After doing the washing machine, he would do strange movements by himself in the living room.

"What is that?"

"Baekbo Shin Kwon."

Her uncle answered in a tone like an AI translator and repeated the strange movements.

"You have to be proficient in various martial arts to survive."

In fact, he knew various martial arts other than Baekbo Shin Kwon.

Han Sooyoung imitated her uncle's posture and asked.

"But is there any use for this? Our country has pretty good security."

"If you learn it, you'll use it someday."

My uncle was a man who firmly believed that an apocalypse would come to this world someday.

"A new world needs new rules."

Now in her fading memory, Han Sooyoung followed her uncle's movements diligently. After repeating the movements and finishing dinner, her uncle would always leave work with the following greeting.

"No matter what happens, don't give up."

Han Sooyoung thought that greeting was hilarious. If she had known that her uncle would soon be replaced by her aunt, Han Sooyoung would have talked more with her uncle.

"Han Sooyoung."

After a long silence, her uncle grabbed Han Sooyoung's small head and said this.

"The apocalypse is coming."

"You always say that."

"It really will come."

"Yes, yes. I understand."

"No matter what happens, don't give up."

What was the last thing she said to her uncle? Her memories after that are unclear. Since it happened when she was so young, it was probably natural. Still, when she thinks back, there were a few things she remembered.

The last day her uncle worked, several valuables disappeared from the house. Her uncle used the Baekbo Shinkwon he had taught her right before he was caught by the police. Rumors that he had gone to prison. Rumors that he had escaped from prison. Rumors that he had threatened to reveal the secrets of her father, who was a member of the National Assembly, and had been forcibly repatriated to his home country.

Where did her uncle end up?

Once, when she visited her mother on the weekend, she asked about her uncle.

Her mother tilted her head for a moment at her question and then asked back,

"What on earth are you talking about?"

Han Sooyoung frowned and talked about her uncle. She talked about the breakfast he had made her, the Baekbo Shinkwon he had taught her, and the impending apocalypse.

Her mother took Han Sooyoung to a psychiatrist. The doctor who had often prescribed propofol to her mother was impressed after hearing Han Sooyoung's story.

"Your daughter seems to have an imaginary friend."

That couldn't be true. Her uncle definitely existed. He made her breakfast.

He told her about a monster that looked like a dog, a monster with long horns, and a dragon that led the world to its end.

He also told her about the Constellations. When he talked about the Constellations, her uncle would look up at the sky with deep eyes.

All of that couldn't have been fake. No one could have forgotten someone like that. But people collectively didn't believe her as if they had taken propofol.

The only one who remembered him was young Han Sooyoung, and so her uncle remained an imaginary friend that Han Sooyoung had created.

Not long after that, Han Sooyoung began writing a novel.

When she woke up from a deep sleep, she felt a deep sense of fatigue and ideas welled up. Han Sooyoung wrote everything that came to mind into a novel.

In the novel, there was the apocalypse that her uncle had spoken of. The main character of that world was a regressor. A regressor who fought alone against the destruction of the world.

"What was your uncle's name?"

Han Sooyoung couldn’t answer the psychiatrist’s question properly. Instead, Han Sooyoung said the name that most closely resembled her memory.

"Yoo Junhyun."

Yoo Junhyun gathers his colleagues and struggles with life in endless regression.

He doesn’t give up.

What if her uncle wasn’t just her imagination, what if her uncle really lived somewhere in this world?

In fact, if his home country wasn’t this world but another world, in a sense, the novel was written to overcome Han Sooyoung’s childhood.

Every time Yoo Junhyun’s regression was repeated, the uncle in her memory became blurred. Her childhood memories turned gray, and Han Sooyoung gradually became an adult.

One day, while she was writing the novel.

—Isn’t this a plagiarism of 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World'?

She read a strange comment.

---

When she came to her senses, Han Sooyoung realized that it was all a dream.

Tsk tsk tsk. As the faint spark illuminated the surroundings, the incarnation bodies of her colleagues on the verge of death came into view.

[Exclusive skill, 'Special Preservation', is activated.]

To be exact, they were the incarnation bodies of her colleagues who were frozen in a state just before death.

Kim Namwoon with both arms ripped off. Lee Hyunsung with a large hole in his stomach. Lee Jihye with critical injuries to her major organs. Lee Seolhwa, who was barely breathing after being burned beyond recognition, and Shin Yoosung, whose vital signs had weakened after a strong blow to the head.

In addition to them, all of the colleagues of <Han Sooyoung Corporation> were stuffed and trapped in pale flasks.

As if time had stopped just before death.

Han Sooyoung looked at her colleagues with her piercing eyes and thought about her 'uncle' once more.

Perhaps the existence of an 'uncle' was a memory that was reassembled after she became an adult—a memory created after she met Yoo Joonghyuk, for example. Because stories tend to flow towards 'empty spaces'.

"Why is it Yoo Joonghyuk and not Yoo Joonhyun?"

Yoo Joonhyun in her memories says.

「"No matter what happens, don't give up."」

"How can you not give up in a situation like this?"

Mumbling in a tone that made it unclear who she was talking to, Han Sooyoung slowly started typing on the keyboard.

「Lee Hyunsung thought. I need training. I need painful and harsh training to stop my thoughts from continuing.」

「Shin Yoosung asked worriedly, "But is it okay to just leave that ahjussi alone?"」

「Lee Jihye frowned. "Then what are we going to do? Seolhwa took him away."」

「Kim Namwoon shook his head. "I told you I didn't like that guy in the first place.」

「Lee Seolhwa shouted. "Dokja-ssi! Where are you!"」

All of [Avatar]'s actions were being created at her fingertips. The created sentences flowed through the story link extending from her and directly toward her colleagues stuffed in the flask.

The story of [Avatar] she wrote will one day become her colleagues' memories. So that they can reminisce about this moment together when they are resurrected in the distant future.

This is her world where she can see the ending without losing anyone.

「Avatar World.」

Han Sooyoung thought she knew why she had been dreaming about her 'uncle'.

Perhaps the uncle in her memory was the first avatar she had created. A strong avatar that would comfort her loneliness and protect her childhood.

The tips of her fingers began to tingle a little. Her vision felt dizzy with a slight chill. This had been happening often recently.

Suddenly, her figure was reflected on the flask fragments. Her figure was much smaller than before.

[Your incarnation body has reached its limit.]

Now, both body and mind were at the limit.

Her story was losing its center and gradually scattering.

But she had to hold on. At least until the end of this story, until the scenario ended.

Tsutsutsut.

Han Sooyoung instinctively put her hand into her bosom. What she was holding in her hand was a small notebook.

A note left by Kim Dokja, who had visited the 1,863rd Round.

「"Don't throw it away, and look at it whenever you have time."」

Han Sooyoung read it.

For some reason, whenever she read that notebook, the aftermath that threatened her would calm down.

However, that effect had been weakening a little recently.

A faint spark flew from the surface of the notebook, which had been scorched by the probability spark.

"Damn it."

A half-happy mutter.

"I really didn't plagiarize."

Soon, the notebook fell from her hand with a spark. Han Sooyoung began to nod off.

Then, signs of the probability aftershock began to appear all over her body. The world she had maintained for so long was collapsing.

At that moment, a door opened somewhere and someone's voice was heard.

"I know."

Han Sooyoung looked up at the man who opened the door and came in with a hazy consciousness.

She couldn't tell if this was a dream or not. Maybe she had created another 'imaginary friend'. In this world where only she and her avatar remained, she couldn't bear the

extreme loneliness, so she created another 'uncle'.

The uncle nodded as if he understood her feelings.

"That's enough."

The uncle said while holding the half-collapsed Han Sooyoung in his arms and laying her down.

"I'll write from now on."

The uncle began to tell a story.

Like when she was a child, Han Sooyoung leaned against the soft sofa and listened to her uncle's story. Even though she knew that she shouldn't do this, even though she knew that if she didn't write, the world would collapse, Han Sooyoung couldn't help but listen.

Maybe it was because she had been writing for so long. Perhaps it was because she wanted to be a reader, listening to another story made by someone else, even if only for a moment. It was a story of a reader. A story of a reader who loved novels more than anyone else. A story about meeting characters from a novel he likes and meeting the author of a novel that he likes. A story about going on an adventure together.

A story about a man who loved that story so much that he became the story itself.

"That story."

Han Sooyoung asked.

"Is it okay for you to tell it to me?"

The uncle thought for a moment and answered.

"Yes."

Han Sooyoung continued to listen to the story with her eyes closed.

As the story continued, the aftershock gradually disappeared.

That day, Han Sooyoung had a dream.

It was a dream about meeting a man she had wanted to meet for a long time.

When she opened her eyes the next day, Han Sooyoung was looking at me.

"Kim Dokja, do you know what you did?"

On a devastated world where all the avatars had disappeared, she spoke to me with an expression that did not contain any lies.

"I will not become tls123."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 892 Episode 49 tls123 (2)

Han Sooyoung asked again in a strange voice, observing my reaction.

"You didn't not know what would happen if you told me that, did you?"

I recalled our previous conversation.

In order to open the door of Han Sooyoung's tightly closed heart, I confessed a secret that I shouldn't tell her.

「"You are tls123."」

If Han Sooyoung of the 1,864th Round had heard it, it would have made her faint. She would have asked what I would do if I told her that, if I was in my right mind.

But I said it anyway.

tls123. The author of 『Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World』 that she's always wondered about. That person is none other than Han Sooyoung of the 1,863rd Round.

And Han Sooyoung, who has [Predicitive Plagiarism], would have vaguely noticed the truth of this world just from my one word.

"I'm not joking. I really don't want to become tIs123."

"I see."

"You think I'm joking?"

Han Sooyoung frowned, as if my answer was not very good.

I added a word to reassure her.

"You can do whatever you want. Yes. Just don't become tIs123."

But Han Sooyoung didn't seem reassured, but rather made a bewildered expression. Then she glared at me silently and reached out her right hand to touch my forehead.

"The state of the story is normal."

"It's extremely normal."

"Did you separate from the main body and cause another problem? Did you get a story that shouldn't be obtained? Like 「Mad Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk」. No. Even if you got a story like that, it wouldn't have been like this—"

A story that shouldn't be obtained.

"I've gotten a lot of strange stories."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', chuckles.]

Hearing the story's voice babbling inside me, I thought about my decision once again.

In fact, my decision was not solely 'my decision'.

This decision was made with two other Kim Dokja who shared Kim Dokja's story with me.

I didn't really talk about this issue with them, but there were things that were felt beyond the [Fourth Wall].

「Han Sooyoung has the right to decide her own future.」

The world we lived in was completely dependent on Han Sooyoung's sacrifice.

The 'Ways if Survival' written by Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round, who returned to her childhood, over a period of ten years.

Because of that story, Kim Dokja survived.

However, in return for writing that story, Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round was unable to meet Kim Dokja again and dispersed into her subconscious. And that is where the 「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」 we know begins.

「And then Kim Dokja thought.」

Does that story need to be repeated once more? Even if all causality in this universe collapses because Han Sooyoung does not become tIs123, can that be a justification for sacrificing one person in front of me?

「Han Sooyoung must have thought about it too.」

Perhaps, Han Sooyoung that day was also at a crossroads with the same choice as me.

And Han Sooyoung made a choice.

Instead of preventing the great tragedy of the universe that was about to come, she decided to save one boy who was dying in front of her.

"Fine. What's the point of talking too much? Don't regret it later."

Han Sooyoung glared at me for a moment as if she was tired of talking, and then sighed deeply again. A momentary silence fell between us.

I regained consciousness completely and calmly looked around. The dark basement reminded me of an old warehouse. Countless flasks were neatly arranged throughout the basement.

I looked at the incarnations contained in those flasks. Characters including Lee Hyunsung, Shin Yoosung, Lee Seolhwa, Kim Namwoon, and Lee Jihye were preserved there with the [Special Preservation] skill. The Blood Demon’s warehouse where the heads of the lions were stored also felt like this.

Do unrecorded stories eventually wear out little by little?

If there was a difference between the two scenes, it was that the incarnations stored in this warehouse were still breathing.

"This is the real 'headquarters'."

I could tell without having to look closely. All the scenes of 'headquarters' I had seen so far were the effects of the [Avatar] created by Han Sooyoung.

Not only the incarnations, but also the [Avatar] that covered the entire headquarters.

She had covered the entire area, including this building, with her avatar and controlled it.

"Were all the people I met you?"

"They move and speak as I write, but they basically act based on the characters' stories. I don't control them at will."

"Is that so?"

"Yes, it may sound like a lie…"

Han Sooyoung smiled bitterly, knowing how her words would sound.

"Are you disappointed?"

"I'm impressed."

"Are you being sarcastic?"

"I'm serious."

In any case, Han Sooyoung did her best to keep her promise to Kim Dokja. Not all of them survived, but she still tried to save 'as many' incarnations as possible. That alone was enough to acknowledge her efforts.

"What happened to the Constellations that tried to stop you?"

"Most of them died when the Apocalypse Dragon was resurrected. There are still some left."

They probably boarded the 'Broken Ark'. Maybe the Myth-grade Constellations she witnessed in her memories still remain.

"Those guys have lost most of their power. The original Apocalypse Breath was supposed to be used to maul them..."

I happened to show up at that moment, and the Apocalypse Dragon's Breath ended up being used to save me from the 'God of the Other World'.

She probably has little chance left now.

"I'm sorry."

"No. Well, it wouldn't be fun if the scenario went too easily."

"Will you use [Avatar] again?"

"Once my power is restored."

"Why are you trying to keep [Avatar] that long? Is it because of your promise with Kim Dokja?"

"That's part of it, but..."

Han Sooyoung looked at the characters in the flask, keeping her mouth shut for a moment.

"Someday, when these guys wake up again, I want to tell them the tale I made."

"..."

"I know. All of this is just my self-satisfaction. It could just be a deception to these guys."

I understand Han Sooyoung's feelings. She doesn't want to clear this 'scenario' alone.

She wants to tell her colleagues who have been working on the scenario together that she saw the end of the world together.

"Is there a way to revive them?"

"Maybe."

Wounds that cannot be revived even with the Life and Death Ring. In order to revive them, a powerful probability that could twist the laws of this worldline was needed.

And as far as I know, there was only one material that accumulated that much probability in this 'Final Scenario'.

"It's the Story Core."

If we use the 'Story Core' that moves the ark, we may be able to revive the party facing death.

"That's right. But there was a problem when you came."

Han Sooyoung got up from her seat and shook out her pants.

I followed Han Sooyoung out of the warehouse. As she opened the lid of the underground passage and went outside, a warm heat that I had never felt before came over me. The Apocalypse Seal floating in the sky and the Ark being stuck were the same as before, but the stars felt unusual beyond the atmosphere.

[All beings in the area are affected by the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse'.]

[All beings in the area are exposed to madness.]

['Interplanetization' is in progress in the area.]

[All living things in the area are experiencing real-time mental power decreases.]

['Twisted Tales' are parasitizing in the area!]

[All beings in the area are experiencing 'Tales Contamination' in real time!]

Warning messages kept popping up.

I muttered to myself, 'Oh my god.'

What is this, having a perfectly good incarnation? Even if I had it, it wasn't an environment where I could possibly survive.

Looking at me like that, Han Sooyoung smiled.

"This is really the 1,863rd Round."

---

Han Sooyoung and I worked all night to alleviate the area-wide debuffs that were pouring down in real time.

Since we couldn't use [Avatar], we moved our bodies ourselves and installed the related equipment one by one.

[Item, 'Area Tale Curtain', is activated!]

[Item, 'Area Offset Spray', is activated!]

[Item, 'Special Pollution Purification Device', is activated!]

After finishing installing the equipment in the main spots, the air in the area changed. I couldn't feel the fear of the Apocalypse Dragon that had been weighing on my shoulders, or the otherworldly story that gave me an ominous feeling.

Indeed, there would be such an item when we reached the Final Scenario.

"Okay. It'll be enough to hold on until I regain my strength."

"Did you prepare for this moment?"

"Why would there be [Predictive Plagiarism]?"

I sat side by side with Han Sooyoung in the front yard of the ruined base.

The sun was slowly setting in the world that was falling apart.

Han Sooyoung must have watched that scenery alone several times. Left alone in this world where no stars were watching, she must have written a story that no one would read on a lonely blank page.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', nods while watching you.]

Huh?

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', watches the two of you and wipes his head.]

Wait a minute.

[The Constellation, 'Great King of Beauty', hides a throbbing expression.]

"Are these message real?"

"Then it must be fake?"

"You said all the Constellations are dead."

"How many guys are left who were on my side? It's the same as being on the verge of collapse."

In fact, the indirect messages from the Constellations didn't have any sense of their original status at all.

"I was lending these guys incarnation bodies through [Avatar] body until recently, but now they're in big trouble."

"Then shouldn't they conserve their strength? If they keep sending out indirect messages like that..."

"Why would they be excited?"

I blankly looked up at the sky.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', is looking forward to your existence.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is curious about your existence.]

[The Constellation, 'Great King of Beauty', is deeply interested in your existence.]

Goosebumps ran down my spine.

I wonder why the Constellations are talking to me now, risking their own existence.

"This worldline finally has something to talk about."

I realized anew what kind of place this worldline was.

This worldline is a worldline where even the 'Dokkaebi King' has lost interest in scenarios.

After the disaster of the Apocalypse swept through the <Star Stream>, there are no more incarnations to create tales or stars to read them.

"Are you having fun, kids?"

Han Sooyoung threw dirt at the sky as if she was annoyed by those stars. The few remaining Constellations in the night sky blinked faintly instead of answering. I understand their feelings.

They just want to read the last story of this world. Even at this moment when their lives are short, the Constellations that are dying while reading their favorite stories. Han Sooyoung muttered as she looked up at those stars.

"I wonder if Kim Dokja is watching this story too."

"He will be watching it."

"Why aren’t you angry?"

"Why would I suddenly be angry?"

"You’re Kim Dokja."

I answered while scratching the fire.

"I’m Kim Dokja too."

"Can I ask a few things?"

"You kept asking me."

"How have you been?"

"Are you asking me that, or another Kim Dokja?"

"Either way."

"I can't tell you with my bare mouth."

"That's what you're going to say."

"You said you wouldn't even become tls123."

Han Sooyoung looked at me with a dumbfounded expression and asked with her lips curled.

"Am I really tIs123?"

"You'll know if you try [Lie Detection]."

But Han Sooyoung didn't use [Lie Detection]. Was it the minimum trust she had in me that she didn't bother to use her skill to check me, or was it her last struggle not wanting to confirm the truth?

"You have the 'writer' trait, don't you?"

I blankly bit my lips like someone who had been unexpectedly attacked.

As if she knew it, Han Sooyoung said with a grin.

"I'll know just by looking at you. There’s a peculiar unpleasant feeling, a kind of nuance that comes from those who try to record everything they’ve experienced."

"I’m scared that someone might hear it."

"It’s a little shocking. There’s a 'Kim Dokja' who writes."

Han Sooyoung looked at me with a strangely betrayed expression, then added with a sly smile.

"But I don’t think you’re a proper 'writer' yet."

My expression hardened at those words without me knowing.

What did Han Sooyoung see when she said that?

Or did she read the story of the 41st Round that I ruined with [Predictive Plagiarism]?

If not…

"You still don’t know how to use [Avatar]."

Ah.

"Do you know why writers have [Avatar] skills?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 893 Episode 49 tls123 (3)

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「Avatar.」

A skill exclusive to replies with the 'writer' trait, and a skill that allows them to create their own clones and perform various purposes, and at the same time, the culprit of all these tragedies that divided Kim Dokja into 51% and 49%.

「Why do writers have 'Avatar' skills?」

The reason has already been mentioned in Kim Dokja's monologue in the main story.

「A job that mainly involves creative work and frequently causes dissociative personality disorder or schizophrenia due to excessive stress.」

In fact, writers do not necessarily suffer from grandiose symptoms such as 'dissociative personality disorder' or 'schizophrenia'. There are healthy writers in this world (I've rarely seen them), and there are many writers who live happily even though they are not healthy (I've never seen them either).

So why did [Avatar] become the exclusive skill of 'writers'?

"Because writers are professionals who write 'characters'."

Even while writing just one novel, writers must become countless other 'characters'. Perhaps Han Sooyoung, who was writing this story, was the same.

Even if the story was a reconstruction of a story she had heard from Kim Dokja, Yoo Joonghyuk, and other characters, the writer must fill in the blanks with her own imagination.

And while filling in the blanks, the writer must become different beings over and over again.

Thus, Han Sooyoung must have become Kim Dokja, Yoo Joonghyuk, Lee Hyunsung, Yoo Sangah, Shin Yoosung... and once again her past self.

When I thought about that, I groaned without realizing it. I looked around at the scenery around me once more.

「This world was still 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.」

Perhaps she had been continuing to write that story even here without knowing it.

"It seems you're not completely untalented."

Han Sooyoung smiled brightly like a teacher who had checked the model answer and asked again.

"Then here's a question. Why can't you use [Avatar]?"

"Why are you so sure that I can't use [Avatar]?"

"If you knew how to use [Avatar], you would have noticed that I was an [Avatar] the moment you first met me."

"If you have [Avatar], can you know that?"

Come to think of it, Han Sooyoung was the first to realize that 49% of Kim Dokja in <Kim Dokja Company> was an avatar.

"I figured it out eventually, too."

"I told you. So you're not completely untalented."

Talent.

I smiled bitterly and repeatedly clenched and unclenched my dusty hands.

I've been through a lot since I entered this world.

There have been many stories since then. From 「Heir of the Eternal Name」 to a Giant tale that hasn't been named yet.

Is that all? I have now earned the title of 'Recorder of Fear'.

"Why?"

And yet, as time passed, there were times when I felt like these 'tales' I had accumulated were not mine.

"Why, can't I use [Avatar]?"

Perhaps it wasn't simply a question about [Avatar].

"Well."

Han Sooyoung seemed to know that fact as well. In the end, the answer to this question was something I had to come up with myself, not something that Han Sooyoung could answer for me.

Nevertheless, I had hope for a moment. It wasn't someone else, but Han Sooyoung. Couldn't Han Sooyoung tell me something different?

"There are things I need to know first to solve that question."

When Han Sooyoung lightly gestured to the air, two [Avatars] that looked exactly like Han Sooyoung were born with a popping sound.

While Han Sooyoung sat down in her seat and smoked a cigarette, the avatars grumbled and started working. Checking the equipment we installed, and repairing the exterior of the base.

"Are you afraid of [Avatar]?"

I asked after a short pause.

"Why are you asking that?"

"I just imagined it. What if I were you."

I could see the concentrated world of imagination flowing in her eyes.

「Predictive Plagiarism.」

She was looking at me now, imagining a me that I didn't say, a 'me' that maybe even I don't know.

"In a universe where countless 'Kim Dokjas' exist, what would it be like for you to live as one of those 'Kim Dokjas'?"

I had never told Han Sooyoung in detail why I was here, and what exactly happened to the 'Kim Dokja' she remembered.

And yet Han Sooyoung was reading the information I hadn't told her.

"Living my whole life doubting who I am. The anxiety that I might be a byproduct of another being, that what I think might not be my complete thoughts…"

I wanted to ask how she knew so well. But there was no need to ask.

Because the Han Sooyoung in front of me was the person who could understand me better than anyone else.

"Was that the case for you too? When you first found out that you were an [Avatar], was that how you felt?"

The woman I asked did not think of herself as an [Avatar]. I also admit that there are many ambiguous aspects to calling her an [Avatar].

However, there is one clear fact.

「The Han Sooyoung in front of my eyes is a being created through [Avatar].」

Regardless of whether she had memories equal to her main body or not, the Han Sooyoung in front of me was born the moment Han Sooyoung first used the [Avatar].

Just because she was born a little later in time, a being born late cannot escape the thought that she is not the 'real' one.

"What do you think?"

Han Sooyoung smiled and took out a cigarette from her bosom and lit it. Watching the smoke spreading out, I unconsciously reached out my hand.

"Could I have one too?"

"Why? Do you smoke too?"

"I feel like smoking."

Han Sooyoung smiled and handed me a cigarette and lit it. As I inhaled the smoke, the pungent sensation of the smoke tickled my lungs.

I coughed and added a word for no reason.

"It’s because it’s been a while since I smoked."

I inhaled the smoke again and let out a long breath. The smoke that had dispersed in a clump soon took the shape of a person with the same body size as me.

Han Sooyoung spoke in a slightly surprised voice.

"A [Smoke Human]? You have quite a unique skill."

"I acquired it by absorbing other 'Kim Dokjas."

"How many people have you absorbed?"

"I don’t know. There were some that weren’t human, and there were some that just existed as sculptures."

"There seem to be many such Kim Dokjas in your world."

"Yes."

"Are you competing among Kim Dokjas? To become the one 'real Kim Dokja'?"

"Similar."

Han Sooyoung was silent for a moment. Maybe she was imagining the bloody battles of Kim Dokjas to become Kim Dokja through [Predictive Plagiarism].

Suddenly, I became curious.

Which Kim Dokja would survive until the end in her hypothesis?

A cigarette butt fell at Han Sooyoung’s feet.

"Are you afraid that another 'Kim Dokja' will appear?"

"…"

"Are you afraid that something beyond your control will happen? Right?"

I couldn’t answer.

Han Sooyoung continued talking without waiting for my answer.

"But that's the nature of a writer's job. Constantly bumping into things that you can't control."

"..."

"You know. Once you create a character, they don't move as we want."

"That's right."

"In the end, we create them while accepting a certain degree of uncertainty. We don't even know exactly what kind of person they will become."

At that moment, I remembered a conversation that Kim Dokja and Han Sooyoung had once had.

「"As a writer, you don't completely control your own novel. If you look back, there are many holes here and there. In the end, reading is the work of connecting those irregular holes in your own way."」

A person who writes something is also just a reader.

A person who weaves a story for the first time experiences his first reading experience by weaving that story.

Perhaps Han Sooyoung is explaining that in a different way.

"You have to learn how to handle [Avatar]."

"…"

"You’ve had the writer’s traits, so it’s a shame not to use [Avatar]."

I know that too.

How foolish it is to have the writer’s traits and not use [Avatar].

But I also have my reasons.

"This world is no longer a simple 'novel'. The uncertainty I created becomes a variable I cannot control. If it were a world that wasn’t real, I could create anything without any burden, but this world isn’t like that."

"You’re not afraid of simply creating [Avatar], are you?"

[The exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', shakes.]

I let out a light sigh. The cigarette I hadn’t even smoked a few puffs of fell to the floor as sparks.

I was afraid of speaking. Nevertheless, now was the moment when I had to speak.

"I’m afraid of stories."

Maybe it was because the person in front of me was Han Sooyoung that I could say that.

"I’m afraid of writing stories."

When I first entered this story, I enjoyed it. On the one hand, I felt the fear of death, and on the other hand, I felt the joy of being able to write all of these things down.

However, as I gained colleagues and felt the stories pile up, my thoughts changed little by little.

My emotions began to take shape when I cleared the Recycling Center, broke the Fear Realm, and put two Kim Dokjas into the [Fourth Wall].

「The story was getting closer to its conclusion.」

It was like an intuition as a writer.

From now on, if I made a mistake, everything I had built up could be destroyed. Regardless of how hard I had tried before, everything could be destroyed with just one wrong sentence.

"If you think too much, you won't be able to write anything."

"Yes. But—"

"Why do you think we write stories?"

Why are we writing stories? There must have been a reason, but suddenly, I couldn't remember.

Han Sooyoung sighed and said.

"I asked you to see the 'ending' of this world together."

"Yes."

"What's your answer?"

"I will."

Han Sooyoung pursed her lips as if she didn't like my answer, then opened her mouth.

"I'll cancel my offer."

"Huh? Why?"

"You want to run away right now."

"..."

"You're trying to stay in this world because you're afraid of seeing the end of your worldline."

"No. I—"

I tried to say. It’s true that I wanted to stay in this worldline. But the reason I wanted to do that was because I thought there was something to learn from Han Sooyoung’s worldline.

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

But I couldn’t continue.

Perhaps it was because I couldn’t determine whether or not my words were true.

Han Sooyoung said as if she knew it.

"I can’t see the end with that pathetic guy."

"Is that so?"

So I’m going to end up like this here too. I sighed deeply as I looked at the smoke floating around in thick clouds.

But Han Sooyoung didn’t finish speaking.

"So let’s do this. You need the 'Ark' and the 'Story Core' to return to your world. Right?"

When I nodded, Han Sooyoung continued.

"And I need the 'Story Core' of the Ark to revive my comrades."

In that moment, I thought I knew what Han Sooyoung was going to say.

"Let's fight."

Han Sooyoung pointed to the Ark in the sky, looking at me who was blankly open-mouthed.

"In three weeks, we'll fight for the 'Story Core' over there."

Three weeks. The time left until my sub-scenario ends.

"If you win, you'll be able to return to the worldline you belonged to. And if I win—"

"You can revive your comrades."

Why? My heart suddenly raced.

"That's right."

"But isn't this too advantageous for you?"

There was no reason for my heart to race. If I accepted that offer, the ending for us was already decided.

A bloody battle that would determine the end of the worldline.

If one side won by chance, the other side would have to face a painful tragedy.

And yet I.

"Of course, if we just fought, it would be a fight I would win. So…"

Looking at her brightly shining eyes, I naturally thought of the next sentence she would spit out.

"I'll teach you everything I have for the remaining three weeks."

With the sound of 'tsutsut', I heard the sound of the world's probability being distorted. The 1,863rd Round's Managment Bureau that had been watching all the scenarios up until now—the 'Dokkaebi King' who had lost interest in the scenarios was moving.

[Sub-scenario content has been updated!]

I could see Constellations faintly opening their eyes in the pitch-black night sky.

As if greeting the audience of this world that was not much left, we slowly stood up from our seats.

The world of the last scenario. What unfolded before us was overwhelmingly vast, but at the same time, there was only a very small margin.

"I'm scared."

"But do you still want to try it?"

I couldn't help but admit it.

Before I could even answer, my heart answered. Was it because I was a writer, or because I was a reader? I thought it didn't matter.

But right now, I—

"It seems fun."

Just I was thinking about seeing the 'next story'.

The last scenario of the 1,863rd Round.

There are now two writers here.

But this time, there was only one story left.

"Let's start."

We drew our swords at the same time.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 894 Episode 49 tls123 (4)

For an hour after that, I was beaten up here and there by Han Sooyoung. Maybe because I was beaten up so much, I could answer Han Sooyoung’s questions right away.

"What major did you choose?"

"Creative Writing."

"Oh, you must have won some awards at the 100th-day celebration when you were young?"

"Only a reading award. Actually, I never learned writing separately, so I wasn’t very good at writing."

"Really? But you must have learned some things when you went to college, right?"

"Yes, I did."

Actually, there were people who taught me. Anyway, I graduated from the Creative Writing Department, and I took novel classes from various professors. However, if you ask me if I learned writing from them, I don’t know what to say.

But there is one professor I remember.

「"■■-ah, are you having a hard time these days?"」

It was around the time when I had not received any requests since my lucky debut.

「"Have you ever thought about writing web novels?"」

At that time, I was still not yet fully into pure literature, so I was depressed because I thought the professor's words meant, "You have no talent at all, so get out of the literary world." But now that I look back, that advice meant, "If you keep dying here, your life will be ruined."

When I think of my peers who are having a hard time in the literary world, drinking, I want to give my professor a tip for his wisdom, but unfortunately, I can't even remember his name anymore. It was because I lost many of the memories I had while going through the 'Fear Realm'.

"At first, it was hard to adapt to writing web novels."

"Well, it must have been hard if you had come from pure literature. The writing style is very different."

"I didn't know I would struggle that much. But I graduated from the Department of Creative Writing."

"That's possible. In fact, our industry has a relatively low barrier to entry, right? Anyone can write if they have a keyboard."

It didn't feel real at all that I was talking about web novels with Han Sooyoung.

"Yes. Anyway, I had a hard time at first."

"No one is good at writing from the beginning. Although there are geniuses sometimes."

"You weren't good at writing at first either?"

"I'm that genius?"

I smiled bitterly as I watched Han Sooyoung smiling proudly.

Even though she said that, I knew that she was the one who worked harder than anyone else.

After all, she was someone who had serialized a novel that only one person read for over 10 years.

"Come on, get up. We have to keep going."

I sighed and got up from my seat.

"Are you going to hit me again?"

"Who said you'd just get hit? I told you to hit me too. Then I'll answer the questions you want?"

"Easier said than done."

"You only need to hit once, is that so hard?"

"It's harder than when I first started reading web novels."

She said one hit, but from my perspective, it seemed like Han Sooyoung was just beating me up under the pretense of training.

"Is it because you've been studying pure literature? Your skill usage is so old-fashioned."

"Honestly, how much pure literature have you read?"

"Your basic stamina is also really poor."

"I've never seen a writer with such good stamina."

"For a writer, stamina that doesn't get tired even after working for three days and nights is a given. In my time—"

I quickly used the story.

[Story fragment, 'Way of the Wind', begins its storytelling!]

「Way of the Wind, condensed into 'Unbreakable Faith', swirled and created a fierce sword wind.」

Han Sooyoung muttered as if it was interesting.

"Oh, this one has good application?"

Even so, my [Way of the Wind] didn’t even brush Han Sooyoung’s collar.

I bit my lips and swung my sword again and again.

Han Sooyoung kept asking questions while dodging my strikes here and there.

"What’s the name of this skill?"

"It’s [Way of the Wind], right?"

"That’s the skill name. [Way of the Wind] isn’t used like that originally."

"I didn’t give it a name."

I’m not Killer King, so I wouldn’t have named every skill I used like "Dark Spinning Breaker".

But Han Sooyoung looked at me as if I was pathetic.

"Isn’t that skill your original? But you didn’t even give it a name?"

"Why do you have to give it something like that?"

"Because it becomes stronger with a name."

I couldn’t understand what she meant.

It becomes stronger with a name?

"Extinction Sword (멸화검)."

As Han Sooyoung muttered softly, a long purple sword spurted out from above the dagger she was holding.

I stared at the shape of the sword spur and asked.

"Extinction Sword? Isn't that just [Black Flame] stretched out and pulled out?"

"Extinction Sword Form 1, Annihilation." (멸화검 제1식, 멸화개아.)

Han Sooyoung shouted the name of the technique without paying attention to my tackle. Following that, the form of [After Flame] wrapped around Han Sooyoung's entire body like a flower bud, and soon deflected all the blade storms created by [Way of the Wind].

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God's', eyes sparkle!]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is happy to see 'Extinction Sword' for the first time in a long time.]

Messages from the Constellations pouring down from the air.

I felt like I could understand Han Sooyoung's words that I had to give it a name.

"Form 2, Extinction." (제2식. 멸화분분.)

Following that, a flower bud made of [Black Flame] opened. The sight of a flower made of pure purple energy blooming was captivating just by looking at it.

The moment my gaze was captured by that scenery, the purple energy that had bloomed like petals scattering fragrance began to pour out in all directions.

"Tch."

I hurriedly activated the 'Blade of Faith', but it was not enough to counter the countless energy of [Black Flame]. In an instant, small scars appeared on my arms and legs.

I was purely astonished by the overwhelming difference in skill.

Just as my skill relied on the source of [Way of the Wind], her skill was also based on [Black Flame]. However, the way she used [Black Flame] was much more sophisticated and delicate than how I used [Way of the Wind].

Han Sooyoung shook her head and said.

"It's not a difference in skill. It's a difference in imagination."

A difference in imagination.

"Even if you handle the story in the same way, the image of the technique changes completely depending on how you name it."

I realized belatedly what she meant. It was true that I had only given it a name, but the image of the technique felt much clearer.

A crouching flower bud and a blooming petal fluttering in the wind.

The established name creates a framework for imagination and stimulates the curiosity of the Constellations.

[The Constellation, 'Goryeo's Swordsman', feels the longing for the Murim.]

Then...

"Storm Wave Fortress (풍랑섬)."

I swung my sword with all my might. The magical power in my body drained away and the shape of the blade storm created by [Way of the Wind] changed.

I thought of the wolf that had taught me [Way of the Wind]. The Wolf of Immutar galloping across the plains of Chronos. The wolves running toward the sunset began to roar all at once.

Kudduddud! The energy of [Way of the Wind] and [Black Flame] collided, creating a whirlwind.

This side was slightly pushed back.

I continued to supply my magical power and added [Baekcheong-ganggi] to the blade.

"White Wave Fortress(백랑섬)."

The manes of the roaring wolves scattered silver. Some wolves were cut to death by the flower petals, but some wolves managed to bite the flower petals. With a sound of sparks, the magical power was canceled in the air, and [Black Flame] and [Way of the Wind] scattered into ash.

Han Sooyoung smiled as if she was amazed.

"You have good learning ability. Is 'Storm Wave' (풍랑) borrowed from Lycaon's name?"

I then activated other stories and skills one after another.

[The story, 'Tenacious Martial Arts Master', begins its storytelling!]

A story obtained from Cheon Gae, The Dragon's Head Ark of Beggar Sect.

[Exclusive skill, 'Nakgak Breath Lv. 10', is activated!]

The long breath sucked in by [Nakgak Breath] strengthened the magic circulation efficiency of 'Circulation Delay'. It was the result of practicing the skill linkage that the Demon King of Salvation had pointed out before.

Han Sooyoung, who had exchanged a hundred or so combinations with me in an instant, nodded and said.

"The skill set isn't that great, but the linkage isn't bad. You worked hard, didn't you?"

I felt elated for no reason.

I worked hard. It felt so good to be recognized for that.

It felt like a certain sense that I had long forgotten was awakening again. Even though it was just clashing swords and telling stories that I had accumulated.

"Don't get excited for no reason. We still have a long way to go. Is there anything else you know how to do?"

"I can use Kim Dokja's power."

Currently, I have accepted the 'First Kim Dokja'—the 'Demon King of Salvation'—and the 'Second Kim Dokja'—the 'King of Fear'. I was able to borrow their powers that remained in the [Fourth Wall] with the power of 'Heir of the Eternal Name'.

"Try it."

"Not now."

"Why?"

"I don't know."

[Currently, a part of the 'Fourth Wall' is being restored.]

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', refuses your request.]

It seems that the [Fourth Wall] is not in good condition. The Heir guy is not listening to me either.

Han Sooyoung asked, licking her lips.

"This is difficult. What else?"

"I can also use Cheon Inho's techniques."

"[Incite]?"

"Yes."

"Then try that."

Despite Han Sooyoung's suggestion, I hesitated a little this time. Because I experienced Cheon Inho's '40th Round' in the Time Fault of the Fear Realm, my [Incite] had become quite strong. Right now, I was confident that even a mediocre Constellation could kneel with just [Incite].

"You'll get hurt."

"Me?"

Han Sooyoung said with a smirk.

"Want to make a bet? If your [Incite] works even a little, I'll grant you one wish."

"Wish?"

"Yes."

"Don't regret it."

I opened my mouth without hesitation.

"You."

I briefly thought about what [Incite] I should do. Since it's my first time, I'll go with something safe.

"You're worse at writing than me."

[Exclusive skill, Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

Tsutsutsutsu.

A spark flew in the air.

Han Sooyoung stared at me blankly. Then, I felt a strong backlash in my incarnation body.

[The story, 'One Who Rewrites Fate', offsets your probability aftershock.]

As expected, I failed.

"Would that spell work?"

"You never know."

"The basics aren't right. Before using [Incite], you should analyze what kind of emotional state the other person is in."

I was about to say that I analyzed a little bit, but stopped myself.

"If I had even the slightest thought that I might lose to you, would that [Incite] work?"

"Then what should I have said to [Incite] you?"

"You have to find that out. Other than this? Nothing?"

"Nothing."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

Han Sooyoung's smile deepened.

"That's pretty good. I almost believed it."

"What a shame."

Actually, Han Sooyoung was right. I still had one more important asset left.

"You, do you have a 'Giant Tale'?"

"I do, but I don't know how to use it yet. To be exact, it’s in a state where it can’t be used."

"What does that mean?"

I thought about it for a moment and decided to be honest.

"It’s not just 'skills' that need a name to be used properly."

"You haven’t gotten a name for it yet, have you?"

"Yes."

"When did you get the Giant Tale?"

"Well, it’s been quite some time."

"Then, the <Star Stream> must have given it to you?"

Han Sooyoung approached me with a puzzled expression and grabbed my wrist. Her story began to rush into me.

And as if to oppose her story, a strong energy boiled inside me.

The 'Giant Tale' was resisting Han Sooyoung’s story. As if it was rejecting all of her stories.

"Look at this?"

Han Sooyoung, who had been briefly confronting the story, opened her mouth as if she found it interesting.

"This guy is refusing to be given a name?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 895 Episode 49 tls123 (5)

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A story rejects its name?

Is there such a case?

"Hmm."

Han Sooyoung looked at my story for a long time as if she had found an interesting subject.

"Has this ever happened before?"

"No, this is the first time."

[Your 'Giant Tale' rejects the touch of the 'Director of the False Ending'.]

It seems like it has a pretty strong ego. Is this guy the same as Heir?

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', giggles.]

Han Sooyoung watched my story's reaction for a moment and then seemed lost in thought. Then she let go of my wrist and asked.

"You, how much of the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion' have you completed?"

Intro, Development, Climax, and Conclusion. In order to clear the last scenario in the <Star Stream> and see your own ■■, you had to complete the 'Giant Tale' based on the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion'.

「The decision of victory of the Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion is completed the moment you acquire the first 'Giant Tale'.」

In Kim Dokja's case, he completed it when he cleared the 'Demon King Selection Tournament' and obtained the first giant tale, 'Spring of the Demon World'. However, even though I obtained a Giant Tale, I never received a message that I had completed the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion'.

Up until now, I thought it was because the tale's name hadn't been decided yet...

"You haven't even received a message that you have completed it yet."

Han Sooyoung nodded as if she knew it would happen.

"You, maybe you won't be able to complete the Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion."

---

I heard from Han Sooyoung about the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion' she had built up. It was an unfortunate incident that occurred because she couldn't stop the conversation that started with 'When I was', but in the end, it was content that I didn't mind hearing.

Because she was someone who had built up the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion' in a completely different way than Kim Dokja.

And my impression after listening to the story to the end was clear.

"I don't know what to say, but... you're amazing."

Just listening to the story was overwhelming.

If I were her, it wouldn't have been strange if I had given up a long time ago. If it weren't for Han Sooyoung, who had [Predictive Plagiarism], she would never have been able to build up the stories.

However, the person in question seemed to think differently.

"It ended up like this, so it's not that great."

I understood Han Sooyoung's words.

There are few writers who like the 'stories' they write. However, stories are usually completed on their own, and writers have to accept that.

While we were on the subject, I briefly told her about the scenarios I'd experienced.

Han Sooyoung nodded and sighed lightly as she listened to my story to the end.

"That's great. It must have been hard to survive in the 41st Round. Isn't Yoo Joonghyuk much weaker there than here?"

"No. Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round is pretty strong too."

"Oh my. Are you protecting Yoo Joonghyuk?"

I thought about Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round for the first time in a while.

I wonder if that guy is doing well.

Since we parted ways when the Fear Realm closed, he must have returned to Earth by now.

At first, I was scared to even make eye contact with him, but now I'm worried about his well-being, so I guess that's a great improvement in its own way.

"But what do you mean when you say I might not be able to complete the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion'?"

"Have you been listening to my story so far?"

"Huh?"

"Was I just bored and talking about all the stories I've built up with you?"

Han Sooyoung sighed deeply and shook her head.

"Your journey has been a series of unbelievable hardships by normal standards. Considering the volume of adventures you've had so far, it wouldn't be surprising if you've gotten a 'Grand Tale' several times."

I thought back on the things I've experienced. When I thought about it, there were quite a few incidents that could be called 'big events'.

"But I've only participated in the 'Grand Tale Scenario' once."

"You can get the Grand Tale even if you don't participate in the 'Grand Tale Scenario'. And you can complete the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion' even if it's not a Giant Tale."

She's right. Kim Dokja of the main story also filled part of the 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion' with a 'Mythical Tale'.

"I do have a Mythical Tale."

I hunted the 'Founder of the Absolute Throne', a God of Another World, and obtained the 'Heir of the Eternal Name'.

However, even that tale wasn't a 'Mythical Tale' from the beginning, and I haven't obtained a Mythical Tale since then.

However, there were several events where I expected to obtain a tale of that level.

For example, when I defeated the Giant Nebula Constellations in 'Ginneung-ga-gap' with the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

When I faced the Giant Nebula Constellations in the Recycling Center and summoned the 'Nameless Mist'.

When I met <Kim Dokja Company> from another worldline, or when I met 'Jaehwan', the absolute being from outside the <Star Stream>. That's right.

Events that even Kim Dokja of the main story had never experienced.

However, even while experiencing all those events, the 'Giant Tale' did not sprout.

"Your first 'Giant Tale' came too late."

I obtained my first 'Giant Tale' after entering the 'Fear Realm'.

"Could it be because I entered the 'Giant Tale Scenario' late?"

"No, your 'Giant Tale' was not obtained by clearing the 'Fear Realm'. That's just a trigger."

"Then..."

"It's highly likely that it was being completed before that."

If it was before that, when on earth did it start?

"Maybe it was when you first 'possessed' that body."

Since the time I possessed 'Cheon Inho's' body?

It wasn't an absurd story.

Just like Jang Hayoung of the Demon World, 'possession' is used as a material for scenarios or stories in the <Star Stream>.

So does the <Star Stream> view the time from the time I possessed Cheon Inho until now as a 'Giant Tale'?

Then something suddenly came to mind.

"I've received a strange message regarding my 'Giant Tale'."

I definitely received that message right after I cleared the 'Fear Realm'.

"They say my story holds the potential for a 'Super-Giant Tale'."

"A Super-Giant Tale?"

"Have you ever heard of it?"

Han Sooyoung shook her head.

That made sense. The concept of 'Super-Giant Tale' does not appear in 'Ways of Survival' or 'ORV'.

"Do you know what a 'Giant Tale' is?"

"Isn't it a term referring to a story with a unique worldview?"

"That's right. Then what is a 'Super-Giant Tale'?"

"Does it mean that it has a larger worldview?"

"Well. Is the size of the worldview an issue?"

"Yes?"

"Giant Tales are also divided into quite a few categories. I don't think they will escape the concept of a Giant Tale simply because their worldview is larger than other Giant Tales."

Han Sooyoung was right. It wouldn't be called a 'Super-Giant Tale' simply because their 'worldview' is large.

In fact, it was difficult to see my 'Giant Tale' as being larger in scale than Kim Dokja's 'Sacred Torch that Swallowed Myth' or 'Season of Light and Darkness'.

"This is what I think. The 'Super-Giant Tale' might be a concept for writing a story with a different nature from the 'Giant Tale'."

"A story with a different nature?"

"For example..."

Han Sooyoung, with a blank expression, was silent for a moment, what she was thinking unknown. Maybe she was writing something like [Predictive Plagiarism].

"A story that can only begin after another story ends."

I opened my mouth for a moment. Han Sooyoung added with an embarrassed look.

"For example, that's what it is. It's just an expression that suddenly came to mind, so don't worry about it."

"Why did this happen to me?"

I don't know. Maybe the <Star Stream> judged that your story wasn't suitable for writing in the form of 'Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion.'

Han Sooyoung added with a light quiver of her lips.

"Well, you'll find out soon enough. Anyway, when that 'Giant Tale' is completed, you'll find your ■■ too."

"I don't even know what kind of tale I'm making."

"No writer knows what kind of story they’re going to tell."

"…"

"No matter how plausible the blueprint is, the story doesn’t always go as planned."

Han Sooyoung took another cigarette out of her bosom and lit it, saying,

"And your story, it wasn’t bad."

"…"

"It’s confusing, messy, and distracting, but…"

Han Sooyoung’s two eyes were looking at me through the lightly dispersing smoke.

"I felt a strong desire to tell that story to someone."

"…"

"For whom are you trying to see the end of the world? If you know that, you might be able to guess a little bit about the name your 'Giant Tale' will be named."

For whom am I continuing this story?

The first faces that came to mind were the other 'Kim Dokja''. Dansu ahjussi, Killer King, Ye Hyunwoo, Kyung Sein, Yerin, and other readers. In order to send them back to their original world, I have continued to tell this story. It certainly was.

"I don't know."

"Don't you know?"

"At first, I thought I knew, but now I don't know. There are so many people who have been hurt by the tales I created."

I often thought.

What if I hadn't been the one who experienced all these tales? If I had been one of the 51% of Kim Dokja, wouldn't I have been able to tell this story much better than I did?

Then Han Sooyoung said,

"Of course not everyone will like your stories. It's obvious, but you can't write a story that everyone loves. Some stories can make enemies and incur hatred just by writing them."

I thought of other readers I had met while experiencing the stories. I thought of the Misreading Association, Gu Seonah, and 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' who had been glaring at me.

"But there will be people who support your stories. There are definitely people who believe in the story you've built and want to complete it with you."

What came to mind with those words was the lonely face of Yoo Joonghyuk in the 41st Round.

"That's why I'm writing until the end. If even one person likes your story, that's what a writer does, not giving up until the end."

The side profile of her as she spoke was dazzling.

Will I be able to make the same expression as her when I finish this story someday?

I don't know now. The only sentences I can write now are ones that tease Han Sooyoung.

"So you've been writing 'Ways of Survival' for Kim Dokja for 10 years."

Han Sooyoung, who had a miserable expression, dropped her cigarette and said.

"I won't write that kind of thing. The author of Ways of Survival is a 'very huge baby'."

I smiled bitterly and answered.

"You still say that? You're the one who's going to write Ways of Survival. And the 'Oldest Dream' that you made into reality after reading that story is..."

"Kim Dokja, right?"

I opened my mouth in surprise.

"Did you know?"

"I expected that to happen. Ever since you started talking about tls123."

"You must know everything now."

Han Sooyoung nodded.

"But don't you think something's strange? What on earth is Kim Dokja that made him such a great person? Why, why was Kim Dokja the only one in this universe chosen as the

'Oldest Dream'?

"That's..."

"Why, out of all the people, did 'Kim Dokja's' imagination give birth to the Star Stream?"

It was a question that had no answer.

Why did Kim Dokja's imagination alone have such power? Looking into her eyes, which were filled with faint starlight, a thought suddenly occurred to me. Maybe she had already done [Predictive Plagiarism].

"This is what I think."

And so, maybe she had figured out the clue to how this whole story began.

"Somewhere in this universe, there must be a 'very huge baby'."

---

From that day on, I learned and practiced various techniques from Han Sooyoung every day.

She explained in detail everything I asked her. From how to communicate with the story, how to train skills, and how to deal with scenarios.

I learned a lot from her in a short period of time. Honestly, if I could, I would have liked to raise the bar.

「And 20 days passed.」

And so, 20 days later.

The day of the showdown dawned.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 896 Episode 49 tls123 (6)

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That morning was the same as usual.

We woke up at dawn, busily cleaned our faces (Han Sooyoung ordered us to do this), did some light stretching (Han Sooyoung ordered this too), and sat next to each other to eat sandwiches made with reference to Yoo Joonghyuk's recipe from the 81st round (we agreed on this).

"I have a question."

"What?"

Han Sooyoung, who was crunching on a sandwich made with ground pup hind leg meat, glanced at me.

"Even if stretching is like that, is there any point in cleaning our faces?"

"The Constellations are watching."

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', nods at the handsome face of the descendant.]

[The Constellation, 'Great King of Beauty', says that the clean incarnation is also nice to look at.]

Honestly, I was impressed. Does this person care about such things even in the Final Scenario?

"They see us even when we haven’t washed?"

"So they’d like it more if we washed."

[The Constellation, 'Commander of the Red Cosmos', nods.]

In the meantime, I’ve become quite attached to the Constellations of the 1,863rd Round.

The Constellations that burn the remaining stories and shine on me.

"Are you ready?"

It’s time to say goodbye to them too.

"Yes."

"What did I teach you?"

"I learned most of it."

For the past 20 days, what Han Sooyoung had been teaching me intensively was how to awaken my potential.

「"You’re already strong enough. You just don’t know how to use your power."」

I briefly told her what had happened in the 41st Round, and after understanding the situation, she advised me this.

「"You don't have to be scared because you're going to fight Myth-grade Constellations. Trust the stories you've built up."」

The enemies I have to fight are Constellations that are comparable to the Three main Gods of <Olympus>.

And maybe the 'Kim Dokjas' who have more fragments than me.

「"If you collect those 'Kim Dokja fragments', you'll get stronger, right?"」

「"Theoretically, yes."」

「"But in my opinion, collecting a lot of fragments isn't necessarily the only way to get stronger. In short, it's like this. The 41st Yoo Joonghyuk isn't necessarily weaker than the 1,863rd Yoo Joonghyuk."」

I listened to her story as if I was possessed.

「"The amount of stories you have is important, but what's more important is how well you understand the stories you have."」

I agreed. I've felt this clearly while fighting the 'Demon King of Salvation' and the 'King of Fear'.

「The total amount of 'Kim Dokja Fragments' that I currently have is close to 30 percent.」

The total amount of fragments that the First and Second had was not much compared to what I had. However, with just that amount of fragments, they showed an influence that shook the <Star Stream>.

In other words, the most important task that I had to solve right now was to 'properly understand' the stories I had.

"[Avatar]?"

"I can't use it yet."

"Hmm."

Despite all the training I've done so far, I still haven't mastered [Avatar].

Han Sooyoung seemed to think it was strange, but she didn't really say anything. It seemed like she thought it was a task that I had to solve in the end.

"You haven't forgotten our promise, have you?"

I nodded.

"We'll go to the 'Last Ark' together and get the Story Core."

"And then?"

"We'll give the 'Story Core' to the winner of this fight."

It was a simple contract. If she gets her hands on the Story Core, she will be able to revive her stuffed comrades in the headquarters' warehouse.

And if I get my hands on the Story Core, I will be able to safely return to the 41st worldline.

"I won't let this be the last time, you know?"

"I don't even want to."

In the meantime, I have fought countless matches with Han Sooyoung. And I have never won against her.

Han Sooyoung, with a dreary smile, aimed her sword at me.

"Then let's see how much you've grown."

A fierce aura rose from Han Sooyoung's entire body. She pulled out a long sword from her waist.

"That sword…"

I recognized the sword at a glance.

"Is this the first time I'm showing you? This is my main weapon."

She smiled brightly and held a super sword in her right hand.

The weapon that Kim Dokja used when he visited the 1,863rd Round. It seems that Han Sooyoung has been keeping that weapon.

"Come to think of it, Kim Dokja gave you 'Unbreakable Faith'."

Maybe that super sword is now her new 'Faith'.

But her weapon wasn't just one super sword.

Sssssss.

The hilts on her waist seemed to multiply, and in an instant, her [Avatars] split into six and grabbed a sword each.

The Holy Sword Ascalon.

The Thunder Sword Gram.

The Dragon Sword Ridill.

The Old Dragon Sword Nægling.

The Dragon Slaying Sword Arondight.

They were all swords used to seal the Apocalypse Dragon.

I swallowed as I felt the immense energy flowing from the six holy relics. Han Sooyoung really intended to defeat me here.

"Come."

Before I could finish my words, the blade of the Dragon Slaying Sword moved towards my Adam's apple.

I narrowly avoided the blade and swung my 'Unbreakable Faith'. With a sharp crack, the Thunder Sword Gram and the Dragon Sword Ridill flew in from both sides, aiming for my sides and thighs.

「Way of the Wind.」

「Tenacious Martial Arts Master.」

「'Circulation Delay'.」

「Naggak Breathing.」

The skills, stories, and characteristics within me were simultaneously manifested.

「Storm Wave Fortress.」

As I swiftly rotated my body and extended my sword strike, the Old Dragon Sword Nægling and the Dragon Slaying Sword Arondight flew in from the opposite empty space.

「White Wave Fortress.」

The White and Blue Sword Energy that extended from my sword strike rushed toward Han Sooyoung like a wolf running through the grassland. She said, blocking the

consecutive attacks of [Storm Wave Fortress] and [White Wave Fortress] with a concise movement.

"You know that won't work?"

As Han Sooyoung raised her Grass-Cutting Sword, dark clouds gathered in the sky.

The shadow of the eight-headed Imoogi was visible through the dark clouds.

The Eight-Headed Monarch, 'Yamata No Orochi'.

The Grass-Cutting Sword she held was a sword made from the tail of that Yamata No Orochi.

The legend contained in the Grass-Cutting Sword was resonating with her [Black Flame].

That was the true power of the 'Holy Relic'.

"Black Lightning."

The shadow of the Imoogi opened its mouth wide, and its eight heads spit out pitch-black lightning toward the ground.

An incredible wide-range attack reminiscent of Zeus's Thunderbolt.

My mouth fell open without me knowing it, but it wasn't the time to be amazed.

"I am—"

I took in all my breath and spat out into the air.

"The Paradoxical White-Blue, 'Kyrgios Rodgraim'."

A combination of [Incite] and [Bookmark].

When [Electrification] was activated, pure white white-blue lightning enveloped my entire body.

[Your current physical composition is different from that of the corresponding character.]

[You cannot use 'Electrification' with your current physical composition.]

[A powerful skill penalty will consume your body!]

Kyrgios is 'small'. Normally, you would have to receive a penalty due to the different incarnation body composition.

[Your 'strength' overcomes the skill penalty!]

This is only when your 'strength' is lacking.

Kwakwakwakwakwa!

I swung [White-Blue Power] ceaselessly toward the pouring [Black].

Han Sooyoung said with a smile.

"A combination of 「Heir of the Eternal Name」 and [Incite]."

A combination of Kim Dokja's [Bookmark] and Cheon Inho's [Incite].

It was a combination that I had used several times before meeting Han Sooyoung, but it was the first time I had shown it to her.

"And it seems like you were aiming for a 「Stage Effect」 as well, is that right?"

"You're sharp."

I briefly hoped that the 「Stage Effect」 that had defeated Yamata no Orochi in 'Peace Land' would activate, but unfortunately, the stage did not open. It seems that my conditions were somewhat inadequate to satisfy the Stage Effect.

"It's increased quite a bit, but it's still not enough. Do you think you can defeat the Myth-grade Constellations with that much?"

Sparks began to fly from Han Sooyoung's entire body again.

An intense sense of pressure that could be felt just by making eye contact.

It wasn't simply because of the amount of stories she had. It was, so to speak, a difference in interpretation.

A Constellation that understood her own stories better than anyone else. The unique force that the being emitted was pressing down on my entire body.

I was convinced. The Han Sooyoung in front of me right now would never lose even if she were to compete with those terrifying Myth-grade Constellations.

"Black lightning."

The sky in the area turned pitch black and once again, a dark lightning struck the ground.

The lightning was twice as large as before.

I hurriedly swung my sword toward the empty space, but the moment it collided with the lightning, a massive shock swept through my entire body.

A terrible pain that swallowed even my screams. A shock that even [Electrification] could not handle shook my mind. Blood flowed from my clenched lips.

"I—"

I used [Incite] and [Bookmark] at the same time once again.

"I am Kyrgios Rodgraim, the captain of the First Division of the Transcendent Alliance!"

The strongest 'Kyrgios' I know. I [Incited] myself as 'Paradox White-Blue', the leader of the Transcendent Alliance.

[Your understanding of the person is lacking!]

[Your interpretation makes up for your lack of understanding.]

[Your persistent interpretation creates a new understanding of the person!]

Han Sooyoung looked surprised as she watched me rise several times in level in an instant.

No matter how much my interpretation improved, it would take an enormous amount of probability to recreate a 'character' of this level with [Incite] and [Bookmark].

"You told me. Have a good conversation with the 'story' I have."

"Does it make sense for the story to rise in level just by having a conversation?"

Of course it doesn't make sense.

But I was able to do it now.

Because, the 'story' I tried to communicate with the most in the past 20 days was—

[Your 'Giant Tale' is looking at you.]

It was my 'Giant Tale'. A giant tale that has yet to be named. A tale that I don't even know when or why it sprouted in me.

I constantly talked to that story, and found a way to draw some strength from it.

[The possibility that your 'Giant Tale' is lacking is shared.]

First Division Captain Kyrgios Rodgraim, who was hunting the Outer Gods of the Fear Realm.

My incarnation body, which had transformed like a single flash of light, passed through [Black Lightning] and rushed toward Han Sooyoung.

The two swords clashed with a loud noise. Han Sooyoung's sword no longer felt heavy.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', can't take his eyes off your battle!]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', hurriedly wipes his head!]

[The Constellation, 'Commander of The Red Cosmos', watches the battlefield with anxious eyes.]

In an instant, we exchanged a hundred or so attacks.

Because of the excessive use of power, my whole body was sweating like crazy.

My vision was getting blurry. Nevertheless, my mind was clearer than ever.

「I need one more sentence.」

A single sentence to defeat her.

Han Sooyoung’s eyes were shining brightly as she swung her sword at me. She knew it too. This match would be won by whoever found the 'next sentence' first.

I was the one who moved first.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???' is activated!]

"Kim Dokja—"

All I needed was a moment of inattention. And there was only one sentence that could bring about that inattention.

"He likes the novel you wrote!"

I couldn’t tell whether [Incite] had worked or not. However, for a moment, Han Sooyoung's breathing was disturbed, and her sword moved. Her Super Sword rolled on the floor with a dazzling flame.

Han Sooyoung muttered as she watched the swordplay of 'Unbreakable Faith' aimed at her neck.

"Okay..."

I smiled bitterly.

"I lost. The Story Core is yours."

I looked at Han Sooyoung for a moment and then put my sword away, saying.

"No, I will not have the Story Core."

"What?"

In the first place, I had no intention of using the 'Story Core' even if I won.

"Let's go get the 'Story Core' together. Reviving your comrades is the first thing."

Even without using the 'Story Core', there might be a way for me to return to my original worldline. For example, I could make a contract with a 'God of the Outer World' like her.

The conditions and methods would be difficult, but I could definitely find it if I tried.

However, Han Sooyoung's expression was strange. An alarm bell rang in my head along with a strange sense of discomfort.

「Couldn't Han Sooyoung have anticipated this battle?」

No matter how unique the strategy was, the opponent was Han Sooyoung.

Couldn't she have anticipated that I wouldn't take the 'Story Core'?

No, was it logically possible to defeat her with just the cards I had in the first place?

My heart began to beat slowly.

The previous battle quickly replayed in my head.

「She never used [Predictive Plagiarism] while fighting me.」

The fact that she didn't use her specialty, [Predictive Plagiarism], meant that she wasn't in a situation where she could use it. For example,

"Han Sooyoung, Surely—"

Or that the power of [Predictive Plagiarism] had already been used elsewhere.

With a loud noise coming from the sky, I reflexively raised my head.

The destroyed Final Ark. Black dust was rising from the stage of our destination, the 'Last Scenario'.

Along with Han Sooyoung's faint smile, the one sentence she had found echoed in my head.

[Someone cleared the 'Last Scenario'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 897 Episode 49 tls123 (7)

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My head was spinning. This couldn't be happening.

The last scenario was cleared.

Why on earth?

"Sorry, this was the best we could do."

As I watched Han Sooyoung mutter, I finally thought I understood what had happened.

"It was an avatar."

Han Sooyoung's avatar, with a faint smile on its face, was looking at me.

The destroyed final ark.

Han Sooyoung's 'main body' was probably inside that ark. She had infiltrated the final ark and completed the last scenario while an [Avatar] was holding me back.

"Why did you do this? We promised to clear it together."

"The ark is much more dangerous than you think."

"I learned from you so far so that we could do that dangerous thing together."

According to Han Sooyoung, what was waiting for us inside the ark were the Myth-grade Constellations of <Olympus> and <Asgard>.

Of course, they were not in their prime condition due to the great blow from the 'Apocalypse Dragon', but even so, a Myth-grade Constellation was a Myth-grade Constellation. They were not enemies that Han Sooyoung could easily deal with alone.

"I can do it alone, so why bother?"

As the dark clouds created by Han Sooyoung's [Black Lightning] disappeared, the Apocalypse Dragon was seen sticking its head through the 'Apocalypse Dragon's Seal' floating in the sky.

I realized why she had created so many dark clouds and used such a fancy technique to summon thunder and lightning. She had used 'Apocalypse Dragon's Breath' to bombard the Constellations in the ark from beyond the scenery created by [Black Lightning].

Judging from the fact that the Constellations were barely noticeable in the ark, it seemed like her gamble had been successful.

"You won."

"Why do you look so happy?"

"Because you'll able to revive your comrades."

Although Han Sooyoung didn't keep her promise, on the other hand, I thought it was fortunate that she didn't keep her promise.

I don't know if it was because she didn't trust me or for some other reason, but she eventually obtained the Story Core. So…

「But was it really necessary to obtain the Story Core in such a 'cumbersome way'?」

My expression hardened at the sudden question that came to me.

If she was going to revive her comrades anyway, it would have been best to just join forces with me or clear the final scenario through an 'Oath of Existence'.

But she obtained the Story Core on her own.

If Han Sooyoung, and not someone else, acted like that, then there had to be a reason for her to do so.

For example—

"You’re not thinking strangely, are you?"

"What?"

"That Story Core…"

"Oh, you wonder if I’m going to give it to you?"

When I nodded slightly, Han Sooyoung added with a smirk.

"Why am I giving you what I worked so hard to get? Anyway, you are also overly self-conscious."

Han Sooyoung suddenly got up from her seat, dragged me by the arm, and hid between the nearby abandoned buildings. Just as I was about to ask what he was doing, Han Sooyoung put her finger to her lips and said, "Shhh."

A moment later, golden stories seemed to be overflowing in the sky, and then a presence was felt from the underground warehouse.

「And so the last puzzle of the forgotten worldline was being put together.」

Han Sooyoung's colleagues who had been trapped in the warehouse were walking up to the surface.

The power of the 'Story Core' had succeeded in reconstructing their bodies.

"Captain!"

"Captain!"

Lee Hyunsung, Shin Yoosung, Lee Seolhwa, Kim Namwoon, Lee Jihye. The main members of <Han Sooyoung Corporation> encountered Han Sooyoung's main body descending from the sky.

The group, who had received memories through Han Sooyoung's [Avatar] link, seemed to know everything that had happened to Han Sooyoung.

「Now they will go to see the end of this worldline together.」

They will enter the portal installed in the ark and defeat the 'Dokkaebi King' of this worldline. And they will complete all the scenarios.

That’s how the 1,863rd Round ends safely.

I watched the people who burst into tears while holding Han Sooyoung in the sky. No matter which worldline it is, the scenery of the last scenario makes people’s hearts strange.

When I looked around, Han Sooyoung was watching the same scenery with deep eyes.

"Thank you, for keeping your promise."

"A promise?"

"I asked you to watch the ending together."

"Did you split an [Avatar] to watch this scenery together?"

Han Sooyoung didn’t answer with a vague expression.

In either case, watching that scenery with Han Sooyoung was meaningful to me.

「Just like Yoo Joonghyuk in the 1,863rd Round, Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round also created her own ending.」

I was so overwhelmed that I wanted to put this moment into words someday.

But maybe it was because of my mood.

While the ending scenery was so vivid, Han Sooyoung in front of me felt a bit fainter than before.

"Now, retrieve the [Avatar]."

I spoke again to Han Sooyoung, who didn't respond.

"You don't have to worry about it. I'll somehow find a way to return to the original worldline. So you should just retrieve your [Avatar] and tell your colleagues…"

"That won't work. This [Avatar] can't be retrieved."

For a moment, I couldn't understand what Han Sooyoung was saying.

"To be exact, I shouldn't retrieve it."

I didn't want to understand.

I didn't want to imagine the other side of this 'finale' flowing deep in my head.

Han Sooyoung spoke as if adding more.

"You did that. The worldline was already distorted."

When I told her that she was tls123, the nature of this worldline changed from the main story I knew.

She learned everything that would happen in her future, and by declaring that she would not become tls123, she changed the development of the worldline.

I thought she had changed it.

「Han Sooyoung has finally found a way to restore the distorted worldline to its original state.」

I blankly looked down at her, then looked at Han Sooyoung’s body reunited with her colleagues from afar.

「However, there is only one prerequisite for the distortion to be restored.」

I felt dizzy.

「Han Sooyoung’s body will forget everything that happened with me.」

I slid down on the nearby stone wall.

"Right now… Are you putting all the memories of our time together in this [Avatar]?"

"That’s right. The main body doesn’t know who you are right now. I have no idea what will happen next."

Han Sooyoung's [Avatar] became a little lighter than before.

Han Sooyoung's plan was clear. She had decided to erase all the memories of the 'future' she had learned in this worldline.

「This was her 'real ending'.」

I staggered up from my seat.

It's not too late even now. I just need to tell Han Sooyoung's true self this fact. Then she can choose again. She doesn't have to become tls123 without knowing anything and sacrifice herself for Kim Dokja.

She doesn't have to become the author of this story.

"If you go there, Kim Dokja will die."

Han Sooyoung's transparent hand grabbed my wrist tightly.

"Everything is already written, and is being written at the same time. You know. It was all meant to be this way."

I couldn't say anything. I was completely helpless in front of the cruel <Star Stream>.

"How much time is left for this Avatar?"

"There's less than 5 minutes left now. Okay, I feel good. If you have any questions, ask. I'll answer them all."

"Why did you make this choice?"

Han Sooyoung seemed to think for a moment, then took out a notebook from her bosom and handed it to me. It was the notebook that Kim Dokja had given her when he left the 1,863rd Round.

"I know you wrote a little bit of new content every night."

"…"

"Unlike Kim Dokja, your writing skills are quite good."

Han Sooyoung said. While reading the words written in the notebook, the aftershock of probability that threatened her also subsided.

So I wrote down in the notebook what I knew about the future. What would happen to her, the colleagues she would meet, and the 'ending' of this universe she would face.

Hoping that she would make a slightly different choice after learning that fact.

"Thank you. And I’m sorry. I can’t take this with me. Then the future will be ruined."

I took Han Sooyoung's notebook.

"Is this why you made that choice?"

"Well, that's not all."

Han Sooyoung scratched her cheek with a smirk.

"Do you remember when Kim Dokja always teased me for being a plagiarized writer?"

I nodded.

Han Sooyoung continued talking.

"This is the perfect opportunity to make that guy the only avid reader of my novel. I can't miss such a fun event, right?"

I opened my mouth in bewilderment. I don't know if she's being sincere or not, but in a way, I thought it was very typical of her.

"You have three minutes left. Do you have any more questions?"

The incarnation body had become more transparent than before.

Now there really was no time.

"From now on, only ask what you absolutely need to. You know there won't be another chance like this?"

A question that must be asked.

Han Sooyoung was right. In fact, I had that question.

I bit my lip for a moment and then opened my mouth.

"Who is the 'Outer God' that you contracted with?"

"Well, I knew you'd ask."

The 'Outer God' that she contracted with is a being that offers enough probability to control that 'Apocalypse Dragon'. If I could find out his true name and make a contract, I might be able to return to my original worldline as well.

"I'm sorry, but I can't tell you that. It's a name that you shouldn't know right now."

"What does that mean?"

I was confused. A name that I shouldn't know right now.

Could it be that Han Sooyoung 'read' something about my future?

"Kim Dokja."

Han Sooyoung stared at me with sad eyes for a moment, then placed her pale hand on my cheek. Her palm was breaking in real time as it touched me.

"Don't worry. You can safely return to your world."

"What is this..."

"You came all the way here to see me, so I should at least pay for your transportation. Right?"

Her fingertips and toes were breaking. The broken stories soared into the sky, emitting pure white light.

A sudden thought occurred to me. Her [Avatar] was now condensed with a vast amount of stories.

A story containing the ending of the 1,863rd Round and the secret of the <Star Stream>.

She could not have been unaware of the value of that story.

"I will fulfill the Covenant of the Other World."

For a moment, a dark energy flashed in the sky. Someone received her 'story' as the price of the Covenant.

The content of the Covenant was clear.

"Send this guy back to where he came from."

A dark light flickered in the air once again.

She smiled at me, who was bewildered.

"Why are you looking at me like that? I'm Han Sooyoung. Do you think I'm going to end this world with a bad ending?"

I tried to say something. But I didn't know what to say. If I said anything, my vision would collapse.

In that unstable vision, Han Sooyoung said.

"It's okay."

What does it mean to be okay? If everything was meant to be like this, what was the meaning of all the time we spent together? If it was going to disappear like this, why did you teach me all those things?

"You have more stories to tell when you go back."

The moment I heard those words, I realized.

She had written down her own story for me, who was about to disappear.

"Lastly, I have something I'm curious about."

I supported her avatar, which was slanted to the side. The avatar was already more than half gone. Her blurry eyes were staring at me.

I realized that what she was looking at was not me in front of her.

"My novel... how was it?"

I watched Han Sooyoung's back as she and her colleagues advanced to the final chapter of the scenario from afar.

「Han Sooyoung will never be able to hear the answer to that simple question.」

Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round will cross the 'Final Wall' at the end of this world and possess in the worldline where young Kim Doja is.

「That's because this 'story' is written that way.」

She will write 'Three Ways to Survive in a Ruined World', become tls123, and save Kim Dokja, but in the end, she will never be able to meet Kim Doja.

「She will never be able to ask questions, and Kim Dokja will never be able to answer.」

Having finished everything, she will be absorbed into Han Sooyoung's subconscious in the 1,863rd Round. And 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 begins.

In order for the story to be complete, the dialogue must not be established.

However...

「Some stories begin only when one story ends.」

I, who opened my mouth, was not the Kim Dokja she knew, and she, who disappeared, was not yet tls123.

However, at that moment, we were a writer and a reader involved in one story.

"That novel."

I couldn't tell whether Han Sooyoung, who was brightly scattering, heard my answer.

[The clear condition of the 'Sub-Scenario' has been met.]

[The 'Covenant of the Other World' is fulfilled.]

However, only the beautifully scattered stories proved that there was definitely a story here too.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 898 Episode 50 The World After The End (1)

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[NOTE 1]

「"In return for loving stories, must we be lonely?"」

—Dionysus, the God of Wine and Ecstasy

---

【He's back.】

---

[You've acquired a new tale!]

[You've acquired the tale, 'The One Who Knows the Truth of the False Ending'!]

A part of the sparkling story was scattered and absorbed into me.

[Some of the abilities of incarnation 'Han Sooyoung' will be inherited by you.]

Perhaps this is the last gift Han Sooyoung left me.

「"Learn it well."」

Even though she knew that this 'ending' would come, and even though she knew that I wouldn't be needed in her ending, Han Sooyoung taught me everything about herself. This was her choice.

Her voice hummed in my head.

As I barely managed to stabilize my breathing, a message came.

[You've acquired the possibility of a new 'Giant Tale'!]

The possibility of a new Giant Tale. Perhaps it was because it affected the 1,863rd worldline.

Normally, it would have been something to be happy about, but there was one problem for me.

[Your 'Giant Tale' is shaking violently!]

[Your 'Giant Tale' is absorbing the possibility of a new 'Giant Tale'!]

As expected.

Han Sooyoung was right.

「"You, you may not be able to complete the Introduction, Development, Climax, and Conclusion."」

It seemed that all the 'Giant Tales' I would obtain would be absorbed into the 'First Giant Tale'.

[The signs of the 'Super Giant Tale' are becoming more evident.]

[You have achieved an impossible feat!]

[The Management Bureau of the relevant worldline is questioning your existence!]

A sign of the aftershock that was slowly coming.

It was the result of me, who was not even a member of this 'worldline', receiving excessive benefits from this worldline. Normally, in this case, the 'Management Bureau' would make one of two choices.

One is to make the entity that has a negative impact on the scenario a 'disaster' and incorporate it into the scenario.

And the second is to banish the entity from the scenario.

[Someone succeeded in negotiating with the 'Dokkaebi King' of the relevant worldline.]

The interests of the Management Bureau coincided with a 'proposal' that came in at the right time.

[The 'Dokkaebi King' agrees to proceed with the negotiation.]

[Someone has granted you permission to use the 'Portal'.]

'Forced movement of the worldline' was a transfer that would not be easily attempted unless at least by a 'Secretive Plotter' level entity.

But there is an entity that can negotiate and pull off that transfer with the 'Management Bureau'.

Han Sooyoung, who on earth did you contract with?

Han Sooyoung said that I shouldn't know that name yet.

But I was the entity that knew the end of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'. Could there be someone whose name I shouldn’t know?

That was when a strange scent wafted from the tip of my nose.

The scent of apples?

My vision shook with the softly spreading scent. The portal in front of my eyes was calling me.

「This is the end of the 'False Ending'.」

I saw Han Sooyoung’s body enjoying a reunion with her companions from afar. I wanted to say goodbye for the last time, but that 'Han Sooyoung' wouldn’t recognize me.

The Han Sooyoung who remembered me is now gone. And I have to live the blank space she left behind.

「"You must be having a hard time too. The end of the 41st Round is set."」

I have to write the next sentence while carrying all the words she left behind.

「"But you know what? Even if I already know the ending, there are stories I have to write."」

Can I do it like Han Sooyoung? Like Han Sooyoung, who knew that she would become tls123, but did not hesitate to move forward toward the same future.

Can you choose an endless eternity just to save one person's world?

[The Worldline Movement begins.]

My vision became distorted and all the scenery became distant.

[A special privilege is awarded as a reward for clearing the sub-scenario.]

[You have acquired 500,000 coins!]

[Settlement of additional rewards is delayed.]

[The Management Bureau requests the Management Bureau of another worldline to 'pay your reward.']

I listened to the message coming in and focused my mind.

【Everything is already written and is being written at the same time.】

Along with the familiar voice, I felt the flow of time and space being distorted.

「'Worldline movement' was successful.」

When I opened my eyes again, what was revealed was a desolate scene.

No sign of life was felt around the innermost part of the 'Fear Realm' where everything was destroyed. Suddenly, the scenery of that day came to mind once again. The destruction of the Fear Realm, and the incarnations of the Fear Realm fleeing on the 'Train'. The constellations of the Giant Nebula that attacked the Fear Realm, and the tail of the 'Apocalypse Dragon' that flew over the Fault. The Gods of the Other World who were running away in a panic from the 'Time Fault' where they had been hiding.

The traces of the ruins that still remained were evidence of the history of that day.

Including the portal I had come through, all other 'Time Faults' were closed.

「The 'Time Fault' in question was closed.」

Time Fault.

Was the story I had experienced really a 'history' that existed? Or was it just a 'Time Fault'?

If it was a story that no one would remember anyway, was there a significant difference between the two?

Woof.

My smartphone was ringing in my arms.

I immediately checked the caller.

It was a call from the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

---

I walked through the ruins of the Fear Realm and talked to the Demon King of Salvation.

—Hey, man! Pick up the phone!

The 'Demon King of Salvation' seemed to have gotten a little angrier since I hadn't seen him before.

—Hey! I told you not to touch that! Do you really want to get hurt? Huh? Huh? Hey! It fell down! Get it back up quickly!

Who is he talking to?

For a while, a clattering sound could be heard from the other end of the phone. It seemed like there was a commotion in the [Fourth Wall].

—Damn, it’s so hard to hear a voice. Why aren’t you answering the phone?

"Did you call me?"

It was strange. My smartphone never rang while I was in the 1,863rd Round.

—Yeah! Do you know how much coins I spend on each call?

"It’s always the recipient’s call."

When I checked my smartphone, there were actually dozens of 'missed calls'.

But why didn’t I know that I had a call? Was it in an area where I couldn’t receive calls?

—No matter how distracted you were by Han Sooyoung, you have to answer my calls.

It seemed that the 'Demon King of Salvation' knew roughly what I had been through in the 1,863rd Round.

"If you have something to say, I can tell her."

—She'd have forgotten everything even if I told you.

"Just because Han Sooyoung disappeared, that story didn't disappear entirely."

If it was none other than Kim Dokja, there must have been something he wanted to say to Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round.

The two had never met since they met in the 1,863rd Round.

—I'm not the 'Kim Dokja' she remembers.

"Still..."

—And you said everything I wanted to say.

Sometimes, whenever I talked to Han Sooyoung, I felt like someone was knocking on the wall at the entrance of my heart.

It felt like someone was conveying their thoughts to me from beyond the wall.

Maybe it was a signal from the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

—I didn't know you would say that.

"You're talking about tls123."

Thinking back, the story related to tls123 was something that should never have been told to Han Sooyoung, considering the distortion of the worldline.

"Why didn't you stop me? There must have been a way to talk without using the phone."

—Are you the kind of person who would listen to me if I told you not to?

"If you were an ordinary person, you would have told me not to."

The story of tls123 was related to the origin of this world.

If Han Sooyoung had not become tls123 and written the novel, Kim Dokja would not have survived and 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 would not have begun.

It means that the very creation of the world could have been distorted due to my slip of the tongue and that this entire universe could have been overturned.

—Does that mean that I had to say with my own mouth that Han Sooyoung had to die in order to save me?

Come to think about it, this was a complicated issue for Kim Dokja.

"Well, you're the kind of person who would rather die than kill someone else."

—You talk like it's someone else's business, you idiot.

"But this problem isn't just about our lives."

If Han Sooyoung doesn't create 'Ways of Survival', not only Kim Dokja's history, but everyone related to us will change. Those who die and those who live will change, and maybe the world could have fallen more into great tragedy and misery.

Even so, Kim Dokja did not stop me. The reason was clear.

"You knew, right?"

Kim Dokja probably knew what choice Han Sooyoung would make.

— Because that's the kind of person she is.

A reader who has read a writer's story longer than anyone else can read sentences that the writer did not write.

— You knew Han Sooyoung would make that choice, right? That's why you were able to tell the truth.

I turned my head and looked at the entrance of the 'Time Fault' I had come out of. It hadn't been that long since I had experienced all those things, but the events of that worldline felt somewhat distant.

"Is what I experienced really 'history' that actually happened?"

—Now that novels have become reality, does it still matter what's real and what's fake?

Kim Dokja was right. Whether real or fake, the story I told with her clearly remains inside me.

Still, if you think it would be nice to have at least one more person who remembers that story—someone who can tell you that the story was real, is it greed?

—The Second and I watched it together. And the other kkoma Kim Dokjas.

I smiled silently.

Kim Dokja wouldn't know. How much comfort his one word is to me right now.

—Are you crying?

"…The [Fourth Wall] seems a bit noisy, what's going on?"

—Are you really asking because you don't know? It's all because of you.

"Is it because of me?"

While I was learning various things from Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round, the Demon King of Salvation said that he spent all his time organizing the [Fourth Wall].

—What do you want me to do if you put all the Outer Gods of the Fear Realm in the library? Do you think I'm Yoo Sangah?

As expected, many of the 'Divine Beings of the Other World' who resided in the 'Fear Realm'’s Time Fault seemed to have been incorporated into the [Fourth Wall]. It was a side effect of accepting the 'King of Fear' as the [Fourth Wall].

—The library almost collapsed...

"But you managed to calm them down, huh?"

—They all liked your story.

My story.

—The guys who would go crazy at the mere touch of me, became like ghosts when the story of the 1,863rd Round began. It got quiet. So in that gap…

Just as Outer Gods were hiding in the 'Time Fault' of the Fear Realm, Kim Dokja said that he folded them one by one and put them like bookmarks between the records of the [Fourth Wall].

I don't know exactly what that means, but I was glad that it was sorted out anyway.

"How about the 'King of Fear'?"

—Second…

At that moment, the phone was interrupted by static and the call was disconnected.

[The <Star Stream> has recognized your existence!]

[The Management Bureau has recognized your existence!]

The side effects of 'Worldline Movement' were finally about to begin.

Tsutsutsutsu.

A light spark shot out from my entire body.

I finally recalled the contents of the 'main story'. Just like when Kim Dokja visited the 1,863rd Round of the main story, those who have experienced dimension movement to another 'worldline' are always given a 'Returnee Scenario'.

This time will probably be the same.

My heart pounded for no reason. Ji Eunyu, Dansu ahjussi, Kyung Sein, Yerin-ssi, Ye Hyunwoo, Killer King… Are they all doing well? And that bastard Yoo Joonghyuk too.

It was finally time to meet them again. But.

[Your 'Giant Tale' begins its storytelling.]

What?

「But Kim Dokja didn't know that back then.」

I frowned at the sentence that followed quietly.

「That the 'reunion' he hoped for in this story would never happen.」

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Episode 1’s name was '완결 이후의 세계' and episode 50’s name is '종말 이후의 세계'. The name of chapter 554 and 555 will thus be changed to 'The World After Completion'.

# 899 Episode 50 The World After The End (2)

I looked at that sentence carefully.

The 'reunion' I wished for in this story cannot happen?

[The 'Giant Tale' stops its storytelling.]

Before I could resolve my doubts, the sentences in front of my eyes scattered.

Why did the 'Giant Tale' suddenly activate?

It wasn't a 'Stage Changing' situation, nor was the power of the story artificially used.

So did the [Fourth Wall] activate and read the story without permission?

"Demon King of Salvation."

I tried calling Kim Dokja's smartphone again.

[Currently, 'call connection' is unavailable.]

What could it be? What happened inside the [Fourth Wall] again?

I took a deep breath and tried to calmly understand the situation. I read sentences that seemed like fatal foreshadowings to anyone, but just like in the main story, not all foreshadowings necessarily came true in the worst possible way.

For example, the story said that 'the reunion I wish for' would not happen, but it didn't say that 'the reunion' itself would be impossible.

Of course, I was a little anxious.

At least several months had passed since I'd seen the group. It wouldn't have been strange if something had happened.

Still, I trusted the group, and I trusted Yoo Joonghyuk, Jung Heewon, and Ji Eunyu. Even if I wasn't there, if they were there, the group would be safe.

They have to be safe.

Kikiri.

The debris of the ruined building made my feet trip. As I stepped on the debris, I recalled the memory of when I first entered the 'Fear Realm'.

Transcendent Alliance. Memories of defeating Fears with Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Anna-ssi, and wandering through the 'Time Fault'.

I also remembered the memory of checking Cheon Inho's 40th Round. Come to think of it, I haven't met Cheon Inho since then. Since he's a 'Recorder of Fear', he probably didn't disappear just because the Fear Realm was destroyed.

The Evil Sophist, Cheon Inho.

The one who raised 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

What was his purpose in the end? Was he really satisfied with seeing the end of the 40th Round's 'Time Fault' through me and driving the 'Public Forum' to its end?

Even though the terrible scenarios had passed, I still had big questions.

I saw the scenery of the training ground where the Transcendents once laughed and chatted.

Kyrgios, Cheok Jungyeong... Did the Masters and the Transcendents safely board the train and escape?

I cast the Fear Realm as if I was reliving the old memories one by one. I walked through the End Zone and then the Middle Zone.

The path that I had to risk my life on when I came in was surprisingly easy when I came out. No Fear stopped me.

Now, the 'Fear Realm' had lost its regional effect. The 'Fear Realm' does not protect or isolate the Outer Gods, nor does it provide the possibility of their existence.

In other words, 'Fear' has now lost its value as 'Fear'.

A world without Toothy Fins or Alien Signals.

The darkness where the story disappeared was lonely and deep. How long had it been like that? A cry was heard in the darkness.

Growl.

I instinctively moved my hand to 'Unbreakable Faith' and looked around.

A unique sensation felt on the fluff.

A God of the Other World.

The entities that appeared in the dim darkness had no head or arms.

Monsters that were once terrifying, but are no longer even terrifying.

I know the names by which those guys are called.

"You."

I looked at the 'Nameless Things' with eyes full of pity.

"Just go. I don't want to kill you."

The reason I couldn't help but say those words was because the 'King of Fear' was inside me.

Even though I was slowly raising the stakes, the 'Nameless Things' did not back down. They were trembling in fear but not running away, which meant that they were not in a position to change their fate between death and running away.

I let out a light sigh and activated the 'Blade of Faith'.

By the way, why are the 'Nameless Things' still here?

This was no longer a 'Fear Realm'. In order for the 'Nameless Things' to spread to a place where the area effect was not activated, the scenario number of the area had to be at least 80 or higher. But is that possible?

【Ohhhhhhh!】

I thought as I cut down the 'Nameless Things' approaching. First, I had to escape from here.

"I'm sorry, but I won't let you."

Fortunately, that wasn't that difficult for me right now.

---

Namgung Myung was carefully walking through the entrance to the Fear Realm.

"Hey, move quickly!"

A threatening shout was heard from behind. Namgung Myung frowned and hurried his steps.

"You all know your quota, right? Those who don't meet their quota today will have their heads blown off."

The expressions of the incarnations next to Namgung Myung darkened at the supervisor's voice.

"Damn, how on earth are we going to meet that damn quota?"

"You're doing this on purpose. There can't be any fragments left from the 'Fear Realm' anymore."

"Shh, be quiet. Then they'll hear you."

The grumbling incarnations were all wearing old martial arts uniforms and their faces were covered in soot. At first glance, they looked like 'collecting slaves' from the Demon World. This wouldn't have happened if they were the ones from before.

Because they were the famous <First Murim>'s Later Rankers.

Divine General, Yeon Gisu.

Little White Tiger, Mo Yongshin.

If the world's best Later Rankers competition were held, they would definitely be among the Top Rankers. But now, they are just puppets in charge of collecting the fragments.

"Myung-ah. What do you think? If you just jump into the Fear Realm during this exploration…"

Namgung Myung shook his head.

"No. You'll get caught."

"Don't you have any pride? Have you already thrown the dignity of the great Namgung Se Family to the ground?"

Namgung Myung. He was one of the Five Great Families that once ruled this 'Murim'. He was Namgung Myung, the head of the Namgung Se Family.

"If Elder Breaking The Sky finds out that you've become like that…"

"Gisu-ya, stop it."

In the end, Mo Yongshin, who couldn't stand it anymore, intervened.

Namgung Myung lowered his head in silence.

Yeon Gisu continued to speak.

"That's enough. No matter what you say, I'm going to jump this time."

"Gisu-ya."

"Let me get my hands on just one fragment from inside. Will you offer it to me as a gift? Absorb it right away…"

"Gisu-ya, stop—"

Yeon Gisu turned around with an annoyed expression at Mo Yongshin’s dissuasion.

"Divine General. Yeon Gisu."

The supervisor with pitch-black horns sprouting from his head was there. The supervisor, who at first glance resembled a devil, tilted his head at an odd angle and glared at Yeon Gisu.

"Su-supervisor."

Yeon Gisu fell to the ground.

The supervisor looked down at Yeon Gisu, who was trembling, for a moment, then tapped his shoulder and helped him up.

"You take the lead in this exploration."

"Yes? But…"

"Why? You don’t like it?"

"No… I understand."

Yeon Gisu jumped up from his seat and quickly took the lead of the collectors.

The incarnations including Mo Yongshin looked at Yeon Gisu with worried eyes.

"Are you okay? If you come forward, you'll be called 'Tail'."

"I know. Even if I do that, I'll only die, right?"

Even though he said that, Yeon Gisu's expression was pale.

The 'collectors' had already been deployed to the Fear Realm over a hundred times.

Over a hundred collections had taught them only one lesson.

「Never claim to be a 'Tail'.」

The 'Tail' of the collection team was bait to lure the 'Nameless Things'.

A nickname given to them because they would cut off the 'Tail' and run away if necessary.

Yeon Gisu bit his lips.

He knew that the day would come when he would become a 'Tail', but he never thought it would be today.

The one who comforted Yeon Gisu was Namgung Myung.

"Yeon Gisu, becoming a Tail doesn't necessarily mean you'll die."

"..."

"Don't worry. I'm here. If those guys come near, I'll let you know right away."

Young Master Namgung Myung was one of the few survivors of the previous 'Fear Realm Invasion'. He had even been contaminated by the 'Fear Realm's Otherworldly Tale', and in exchange for surviving the contamination, he was able to sense 'Outer Godes' approaching from afar.

Yeon Gisu stared blankly at Namgung Myung and asked.

"Myung-ah. But wouldn't it be possible with your ability?"

"What?"

"Running away into the Fear Realm."

"Are you still hearing that?"

"You can sense the Outer Gods approaching. Then you could probably run away from them even inside the Fear Realm."

Namgung Myung, who was silent for a moment, asked.

"If you run away like that? What would change then?"

"You can look for the disappeared Transcendents."

The disappeared Transcendents.

Yeon Gisu's eyes were agitated.

"We're going to find humanity's last hope. You know? They'll never turn away from us. If they see what Murim has become, if they see what those Giant Nebula guys have done, they'll never—"

"Gisu-ya, forget it."

Namgung Myung's voice, as heavy as his heart, his gaze wandering through the darkness of the Fear Realm was recalling a scene from the distant past.

"Even that Breaking The Sky Sword Saint was defeated."

"…"

"Even the Murim gods we thought were stronger than anyone else were defeated by those guys."

"So you're saying we should give up here? There are many other Transcendents besides Breaking The Sky Sword Saint. If we can find even one of them…"

"It's been a long time since the Fear Realm met its end. And yet no one besides Breaking the Sky Sword Saint has come to help us. What do you think that means?"

Yeon Gisu, who had been biting his lips as if he didn't want to admit it, spoke again.

"I don't know. There could be some circumstances. And. Breaking The Sky Sword Saint-nim didn't lose to them. Breaking The Sky Sword Saint-nim just—"

"Yeon Gisu, here he comes."

Yeon Gisu turned around in front at Namgung Myung's signal. Although it wasn't in his sight yet, he could feel the darkness stirring.

Namgung Myung quickly added.

"Hold on to the Sananghyang and run to the darkness diagonally to the right. Make a big circle in that direction, then run east, count to 30 minutes, and then return following the scent."

[NOTE 1]

Yeon Gisu nodded. Namgung Myung had just told him the only way to survive from the 'Nameless Things'.

"Let's meet alive."

Yeon Gisu jumped into the darkness with those words. His goal was to draw the attention of the 'Nameless Things' until the first collection was over.

But at that moment, a ray of light flew in from behind the group.

"Ahhh!"

With a scream, Yeon Gisu was seen rolling on the floor.

A sharp beam of light was piercing Yeon Gisu's thigh.

It was clear who had thrown the spear.

"Divine General Yeon Gisu did not meet half of his quota at the last party."

The supervisor was saying.

"If you don’t fill up the quota, that’s what’s going to happen."

The limping Yeon Gisu screamed.

Then something emerged from the darkness. It was Nameless Things. They rushed straight to Yeon Gisu and started tearing at his flesh.

"S-save me—"

The few remaining post-war survivors in Murim died in an instant.

Namgung Myung, who confirmed his friend’s death, turned his head toward the supervisor.

"Supervisor, he was bait."

"So?"

"If the bait is already dead, the mortality rate of the remaining members will increase."

"We won’t consider mortality rates from this exploration. We’ll hunt the Nameless Things that appear and advance deeper. There’s nothing to gain from the Entrance Area anymore."

The supervisor said that and started to lead the way. Every time the dazzling sword pierced through the darkness, the 'Nameless Things' fell one by one.

The incarnations who were watching the scene from behind sighed.

"Oh my god, I didn’t know the supervisor was that strong…"

"I heard that they received fragments of debris from a Giant Nebula."

Fragments of debris.

「The 'pieces' left behind by the 'King of Fear' as it disappeared.」

A divine being that could gain power comparable to a 'constellation' with just a single small fragment.

The reason they came to the 'Fear Realm' right now was precisely to collect the fragments of that King of Fear.

After killing three or four more 'Nameless Things,' the supervisor turned around and asked.

"Namgung Myung, how many more are left?"

"About ten."

"What's the rank?"

"The lowest rank."

"That's worth a try. Everyone, wake up and follow me. Today, we're going to the 'Middle Zone'."

The supervisor, who had only recently gained strength, seemed to want to test his own strength.

When the supervisor, who was swinging his sword recklessly, had advanced a certain distance, Namgung Myung quietly whispered to Murong Xin behind him.

"Murong Xin, count to ten and run away."

"What? What nonsense are you talking about? Didn't you see Gisu die earlier?"

Anyone who runs away gets killed. That's the rule of this 'Exploration Team'.

But Namgung Myung shook his head.

"This exploration will fail."

In Namgung Myung's left eye, which was strangely shining, a story of another world was shining.

Mo Yongshin muttered in a voice of shock.

"Myung-ah, you wouldn't..."

In the past hundred or so explorations, Namgung Myung had only made a few expressions like that. The last time he made an expression like that, the 'Natural Disaster-level Fear' 'Toothed Fin' descended.

"You can run away now. The supervisor went too deep because he was drunk on his own power."

"And you? What about you?"

Namgung Myung silently pointed to his neck. Unlike the other incarnations, he was wearing a black belt that reminded him of a dog collar.

"If I run away, the supervisor will notice."

"..."

"Gisu is dead. I can't lose you too."

Mo Yongshin pursed his lips several times toward his friend. Then he bowed his head and said.

"I'm sorry, Myung-ah."

Mo Yongshin immediately started running backwards with those words. The other incarnations, sensing something strange, also noticed and followed Mo Yongshin.

When more than half of the collection team had run away, the supervisor, who belatedly noticed the situation, shouted.

"What? Where did everyone go?"

The grumbling supervisor approached Namgung Myung. Then Namgung Myung said.

"Supervisor."

"What?"

"Coming."

With those words, a group of 'Nameless Things' appeared from behind and attacked the supervisor.

"These damn things—"

【Oooooooh!】

"This kind of thing, this kind of thing—"

In an instant, five or six Nameless Things rushed in and bit the supervisor's arms and legs.

They shook them off, cut them, and stabbed them.

However, when one died, another one appeared and lifted the supervisor.

"Didn't you say ten, ten!"

The supervisor, whose body was now dripping with tears, shouted at Namgung Myung in a bloodshot voice.

"You bastard—"

A giant baby appeared from behind and swung its arms and cut off the supervisor's neck.

It was a vain end considering the fear it had caused the later indices.

Namgung Myung smiled in vain as he watched the monsters.

Were there still so many 'Nameless Things' hiding?

Namgung Myung knelt down and slowly sank to his knees in front of the approaching disaster.

He lost his father, and the Breaking The Sky Sword Saint he respected. And now even his old friend had left him.

There was no hope for him to survive like this.

His Murim had already been destroyed.

The day that would come someday had simply come a little earlier.

Then, the 'Nameless Things' that surged in covered his entire body. The sensation of them brushing past his shoulders, torso, and head.

But why?

The Gods of the Other World did not attack him.

Was it because he did not react to the attack? Or was it because of the 'story of the other world' that was embedded in him?

He could not tell for sure which.

He slowly opened his eyes and looked, and the 'Nameless Things' were a little strange.

Their movements were strangely different from usual, as if they were ignoring him. Namgung Myung, who always ran away, immediately noticed their state. He noticed.

'Running away from something.'

Something was walking towards the end of the waves of 'Nameless Things'.

He didn't know for sure, but if it was enough to make the 'Nameless Things' terrified, it must be a powerful Outer God comparable to a 'Natural Disaster'.

Namgung Myung shouted with a trembling voice.

"Outer God! I will make a contract with you!"

He continued to speak with his eyes tightly shut. He knew that the Outer God wouldn't understand his language. He knew that they would burst his existence like a bug. But this was all he could do.

"I will offer up all the stories I have! Please destroy this world! Those damned Constellations, all the Constellations—"

He wanted to convey his despair to the outsider, even if it was just a single word.

But.

"Excuse me."

The outsider answered.

When he slowly opened his eyes, a man was standing before his eyes.

At first, he thought he was a monster in the form of a person, but something was different. He could definitely feel the aura of a person, but at the same time, there was a certain aura he could feel from him.

It was the aura that Namgung Myung had longed for, the 'arrogance' that only those who had trained in the 'Time Fault' for a long time could exude.

"Now, just hearing the words 'destruction' or 'contract' gives me goosebumps."

Namgung Myung blankly looked up at the man. The words that had escaped his throat lingered on the tip of his tongue for a long time.

"Could it be... Are you a member of the Transcendent Alliance?"

Then the man smiled brightly and said.

"Yes, I am the youngest of them."

"Why, why did you come now?"

"That is..."

It had been a long time.

But it seemed to be the same for the man too.

"There are still too many stories I don't know."

Eight years after the destruction of the Fear Realm.

The last survivor of the Transcendent Alliance finally returned to the scenario area.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: I could find the suitable meaning of 'Sananghyang' but it seems like a 'protective charm' or something similar in meaning.

# 900 Episode 50 The World After The End (3)

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[Main Scenario #■■ - 'Fear Realm Expedition' has ended!]

The main episode 'Fear Realm' has been cleared. The strange thing is that even though the scenario has been cleared, the scenario number has not been unlocked.

Well, considering what happened inside, the Management Bureau must have had a hard time assigning scenario numbers.

Considering that Giant Nebulae and Mythical Constellations appeared and Natural Disaster-level Fears ran rampant, it wouldn't have been strange if the scenario difficulty had been around 70 or higher.

[Your 'Fear Realm Exploration' is 300%.]

Not 100%, but 300%.

I invaded the 'Fear Realm's' End Zone, joined the 'Transcendent Alliance', and even faced and fought the 'King of Fear'.

If you don't give me proper recognition, I'll be the one who feels bad.

[A 'Temporary Channel' is in operation in the area.]

[Some Constellations are curious about your identity!]

The Constellations didn't seem to recognize me right away. Right now, I was wearing the hood I received when I crossed over from the 1,863rd Round. It was something Han Sooyoung had given me.

「"Wear it later. You never know what might have happened in your worldline. It's an item that makes it difficult to identify your identity."」

「"You want me to live in a state of exhaustion?"」

「"Because the Constellations are having fun."」

「"What a genius writer."」

In fact, in the air, there was a guy who had been curious about my identity for a while, sending me an indirect message.

[The Constellation, 'Master of White Deer Lake', is curious about your identity.]

'Master of White Deer Lake'.

A Nebula came to mind.

But why was that 'Nebula's' Constellation on the Temporary Channel?

The question didn't last long. That was why the message from the Management Bureau that followed filled my head.

[The Management Bureau is checking the clear record of the scenario in question!]

[The Dokkaebis of the Management Bureau are not convinced that you cleared it.]

[The Management Bureau is conducting a full investigation of the scenario.]

Are you saying you don’t want to give me a reward?

Since the scenario wasn’t even numbered, there was a possibility that I would receive a poor reward with some ridiculous excuse.

[The Management Bureau has checked your scenario clear record.]

However, the <Star Stream> knows what happened that day, and the Constellations remember it.

A great number of Constellations participated, comparable to the 'Giant Tale Scenario', and just as many Constellations fell.

I barely made it out of that terrible scenario.

If my contribution is not acknowledged here, it will not only damage the prestige of the Management Bureau, but also the probability of the <Star Stream> as a whole.

[The <Star Stream> acknowledges your eligibility for a reward.]

As expected. Then, let's start with the reward...

[The 'Returnee Scenario' that was supposed to be given to you has been temporarily postponed.]

I looked up into the air with a slightly embarrassed heart. Not another scenario, but the 'Returner Scenario' was postponed?

The main story's development flowed through my head. Even Kim Dokja, who had been to the 1,863 Round, had not experienced something like this.

[A 'Dokkaebi in Charge' will be dispatched to you soon.]

'Dokkaebi in Charge' dispatched.

I was momentarily silent, but soon I thought it was better. Rather than receiving a mediocre reward, it might have been better to request a private meeting with that Dokkaebi in charge and receive a proper reward.

More than anything, there is the 'Demon King of Salvation' here, so there is no need to be pushed back.

[A temporary scenario will be issued to you!]

[The sub-scenario, 'Familiar Sky' has begun!]

**<Sub-scenario - Familiar Sky>**

Category: Sub

Difficulty: B

Clear Conditions: You are the first survivor after the 'End of Fear'. Check the progress of the scenario that occurred while you were away.

Time Limit: 3 days

Reward: 5 D-coins

Failure: –

Sub-scenario 'Familiar Sky'.

This was a sub-scenario that incarnations who temporarily visited other dimensions often received.

It seemed to mean that they were to perform this or that until the 'Dokkaebi in charge' was dispatched… But I saw one thing that bothered me. It was something that was listed as a reward.

…D-coin?

That was when the man who had been walking with me at the entrance to the Fear Realm spoke.

"I, Benefactor."

"Yes."

"My name is Namgung Myung."

Come to think of it, we hadn't even properly introduced ourselves while walking together.

I answered with an embarrassed smile.

"Ah, you're from Namgung Se Family."

Looking back, I had a small connection with 'Namgung Se Family'.

When the 'Fear Realm Expedition' was called, I had participated in the expedition with the help of Namgung Se Family's head, Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon.

Namgung Myung nodded vigorously as if he had gained strength from my answer.

"Yes, the head of the Namgung Se Family at that time. Now it is just a name in name only."

The head of the Namgung Se Family. When I heard that, things came to mind.

「"Father! Please save me! Father!"」

A young man from a prestigious family who was contaminated by the tales of the other world and cried out for his father.

Although his face was much older than I remembered, the man in front of me seemed to be the same martial artist from back then.

In other words, the man in front of me was the son of the Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon.

"Is the Emperor's Sword okay?"

"Do you know my father?"

I know. A greedy old man who advertised a dumpling franchise by selling the story of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"I met him once before."

Still, the Emperor's Sword called me a god and I was able to repair my incarnation body. It was part of business, but I wasn't completely ungrateful.

I thought I should buy him dumplings when we met this time.

"My father passed away a few years ago."

Unfortunately, those dumplings were no longer edible.

"I-I'm sorry."

"No. It’s nice to see someone who remembers my father after a long time.”

A faint longing appeared in Namgung Myung’s eyes and disappeared. He quickly collected his emotions and added with a smile.

"I have received the grace of the Great Swordsman this time. May I ask your name?"

I was about to answer, 'Kim Dokja', as usual, but stopped.

[The Constellation, 'Master of White Deer Lake,' listens to your answer.]

Come to think of it, the name 'Kim Dokja' was already well-known even before I entered the Fear Realm.

Since I've decided to hide my identity, I think it would be better to just watch the situation unfold here for a while.

"Actually, I don't remember. It seems that I lost some of my memories while staying in the 'Fear Realm'."

Namgung Myung looked surprised, but soon seemed to believe me.

"Oh, you were consumed by Fear."

"I think so."

"Well, it's the 'Fear Realm', not anywhere else... Among my friends, there is a guy who faints at the sight of a white ladder because he is consumed by Fear."

A white ladder? Did he see an 'Alien Traffic Light'?

"That Fear is scary."

"As expected, even Benefactor knows about the dangers of 'Disaster-level Fear'."

"Hmm, yes."

What kind of expression would Namgung Myung make if he found out that I could control that Traffic Light?

"If you're suffering from memory loss, even Benefactor must have been trapped in a 'Disaster-level' or higher Fear for a long time."

Disaster-level…

I smiled and replied.

"Yes, similar."

"Then you don’t know much about what happened inside the Fear Realm?"

"I know that the Fear Realm has fallen, but…"

"Do you also know that the King of Fear is dead?"

"Yes. I know that."

Then, as if it were easy to explain, Namgung Myung nodded.

"Right now, the outside is suffering because of that."

"It happened inside the Fear Realm, but did it have any influence on the outside?"

"To be exact, it was a riot caused by the 'ruin' he left behind."

The 'ruin' left behind by the King of Fear.

Somehow, I felt like I knew how the situation was going.

"Are there fights over the tales of the dead Outer Gods?"

"That's right."

"But most of his tales must have disappeared with the fall of the Fear Realm."

"Ah, Benefactor, you felt it too. As Benefactor said, the 'Great King of Fear's' great ruins were reportedly stolen by Outer Gods of the level of Myths on the day the 'Fear Realm' fell..."

So that's how the events of that day became known.

Suddenly, I became a Myth-grade Outer God.

"The other small fragments of the ruins were scattered all over the Fear Realm. Since that day, traces of the 'King of Fear' have been found in the appendix of the 'Nameless Things' and 'Divine Beings of the Other World' that appear in the Fear Realm."

"Could it be that Namgung Young Hero entered the Fear Realm because...?"

"Yes. That's right. I am collecting the 'crumbs' of the ruins under the orders of the corporation."

Corporation?

"What is a 'corporation'? Did something like that exist in the 'First Murim'?"

"Ah, Benefactor, you may not know. I'm at a loss as to where to begin explaining this. May I ask when you first entered the Fear Realm?"

"Um, I don't have a good sense of time either."

"That could be possible. Then do you remember which Expedition you participated in?"

I tried to recall my memories for a moment.

"I think it was the 191st Expedition."

"The 191st? Oh my. Benefactor, you were a survivor of 'that day'."

I recalled the scene of 'that day' that Namgung Myung had spoken of.

The day the Great Hall opened and 'Tooth Fin' appeared in the Blue Dragon Castle of the 'First Murim'.

At that time, I dragged him into the 'Fear Realm' to prevent the destruction of the 'First Murim'.

"Then you can't help but not know. First, let me tell you the conclusion."

Namgung Myung sighed with a worried expression on his face, as if he was worried that I might be shocked, and added the following.

"The 'First Murim' that Benefactor knows about was destroyed eight years ago."

---

The destruction of the 'First Murim' was an episode that was covered several times in 'Ways of Survival'. It was destroyed by the invasion of a Giant Nebula or an invasion by Outer Gods, was consumed as a lower scenario area of <Emperor>, and there was a bloody disaster caused by a rebellion of a lower Murim.

Not to mention, in the main story, it almost was destroyed by the invasion of the 'Divine Being of the Other World'.

So the problem was not the destruction of Murim itself.

"How many years?"

Namgung Myung answered with a trembling face as I asked him with a dumbfounded expression.

"Eight years."

Eight years.

For the Constellations, the God of the Outer World, and the Transcendents of the 'Time Fault', it was almost a moment.

However, in the 'main story', if the 'main scenario' is the standard, the story is different.

I felt dizzy.

Even in the past, there were times when Kim Dokja would deviate from the main scenarios for three years, but he had never disappeared for eight years.

「I wonder what happened to all the party members.」

My heart was beating dangerously.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'activated!]

If there was even one person who thought of me right now, I could connect with them.

However, even though I activated [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], there was no one I could contact. It meant that no one was thinking of me.

Eight years was that kind of time.

「It felt like I was left alone in the vast universe.」

It felt as if my existence had been taken out of the center of the story and thrown into the middle of nowhere.

It was the moment when my first goal after returning was naturally set.

「I have to meet the party members again. I have to hear what happened.」

The problem was that 'goal' could not be achieved.

「If it’s not that they don’t think of me, but that they can’t think of me?」

I thought with my lips tightly shut. It wasn’t time to make such ominous predictions yet.

It’s okay if no one thinks of me. Even if [Omniscient Reader’s Viewpoint] doesn’t activate, there’s a way to connect directly to at least one person.

[Use the item, 'Midday Tryst'!]

I once connected a direct line to 'Midday Tryst' with Yoo Joonghyuk. If he’s alive, the line will definitely respond.

After a while, a message appeared before my eyes.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 901 Episode 50 The World After The End (4)

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[The person is currently in an unreachable area.]

I blinked stupidly.

An unreachable area?

[There are unread messages left in 'Midday Tryst'.]

The fact that there are unread messages means that 'Midday Tryst' is still functioning normally.

In other words, Yoo Joonghyuk was paying coins to maintain this connection on my behalf.

This is a little touching, isn't it?

[There are ??? missed messages.]

[The usage fee for 'Midday Tryst' is currently partially overdue.]

Huh?

[The usage fee is currently overdue for 32 days.]

[To check the missed messages, pay the overdue usage fee.]

Hey, you bastard, you didn't pay everything, did you?

I thought about it for a moment and paid the fee. It's not even a few years, it's only 32 days overdue, so I can pay it. There might be an important message.

[Payment of overdue fee has been completed.]

I checked the message right away.

[The message is damaged and unreadable.]

I don't know why, but the message was seriously damaged.

Come to think of it, there was something similar in the main story. What did Kim Dokja do then?

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

That's right. Kim Dokja in the main story used the power of the [Fourth Wall] to decipher the damaged message. Then, should I do the same?

[Someone on the 'Fourth Wall' says that they can decipher the message.]

If it's someone on the [Fourth Wall], it must be the 'Demon King of Salvation'. Or the 'King of Fear'? Or maybe the kkoma Kim Dokjas?

It didn't matter which one. Right now, finding out the contents of the message was the priority.

'Decipher it.'

As soon as I answered, I felt the [Fourth Wall] wriggling. And after a while, the interpreted message appeared on the smartphone screen.

「I d i ot.」

This was the first message.

「I d i ot.」

Again?

Hmm, right. If it's Yoo Joonghyuk, then that's possible.

Since we broke up like that in the Fear, he might be mad at me.

「I d i ot.」

I stared at the screen for a moment.

This seems like someone is interpreting it maliciously on purpose. Come to think of it, weren't the Kim Dokja clan the masters of 'misunderstanding Yoo Joonghyuk' for a long time?

I continued reading the interpreted message.

「Are you a li ve ? ?」

「I ? curr en tly belo ng ? 」

「You r ? na me is ? 」

Unfortunately, the recovered messages were impossible to properly confirm their contents.

The only one that was intact was...

「Ne bu la Batt le」

The Nabulae waged war?

Is that what it means?

「? ? co in ? ?」

This seems to be something related to coins. Is it related to that 'D Coin'?

「Kim Dok ja, be ca re ful」

That was Yoo Joonghyuk's last message.

Kim Dokja, be careful.

I read the message over and over again. It didn't seem like there were any hidden clues like vertical reading or anagrams.

So, was it really telling me to be careful?

...That couldn't be true.

Above all, Yoo Joonghyuk wouldn't have used coins to leave such a simple message.

"Benefactor, we've arrived."

While I was lost in thought, the entrance to the swirling portal quickly approached. If I go past that, I'll see the scenery of the 'First Murim'.

No, since the 'First Murim' has been destroyed, I wonder if I'll see a different scenery.

Namgung Myung, who had been watching me for a moment, asked.

"Can I ask you a few questions before we go through the portal?"

"Yes. Sure."

"Benefactor, what stage of 'Transcendence' have you reached?"

I wondered why he suddenly asked that, but upon thinking about it, Namgung Myung knew that I belonged to the 'Transcendence Alliance'.

"Well, that's... Strictly speaking, I'm not a Transcendent. I failed to break through the First Stage of Transcendence."

There are several conditions for achieving Transcendence in 'Ways of Survival'.

For example, reaching a total ability score of 100, or 'forgetting' a skill whose proficiency has reached its limit...

"You failed to achieve Transcendence?"

"Yes. It just so happened. That's why I was persecuted a lot."

In fact, when I first entered the 'Fear Realm', my goal was to achieve 'Transcendence'.

For example, integrating the Transcendence's incarnation and the Constellation's soul into one being, just like Goryeo's First Swords Cheok Jungyeong did. In fact, my incarnation was precisely trained through the Time Fault, and I came pretty close to the First Stage of transcendence.

However, that was it, and I was unable to achieve transcendence.

Towards me who could not achieve transcendence, Chunghuh, the Commander-in-Chief of the Transcendence Alliance, said this.

「"Transcendence can only be achieved by forgetting what you have, but it seems like there is something you must not forget."」

Something I must not forget.

「"'Transcendence' may not be the only answer to reach 'after destruction'. Struggling to remember everything could also be another possibility for repair."」

When I relayed that story to Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd Round, Han Sooyoung said this.

「"You're Kim Dokja."」

Han Sooyoung clicked her tongue as if to ask why I was thinking so hard and added.

「"If you achieve 'transcendence' in your current state, you might actually be lowered in rank. Do you know that Transcendence is a state that is reached by studying and training for a long time on a 'single story'?"」

「"It is."」

「"If you do that, your understanding of a single story will deepen, but your overall worldview will narrow. You have to become stronger in a different way than other Transcendents. In other words, readers have their own lives."」

All the way to the 1,863rd Round, I was absorbed in that 'Kim Dokja's Way' with Han Sooyoung.

Of course, Namgung Myung, who couldn't know about this secret, had a somewhat dark expression.

"I see. You're not a Transcendent..."

"Are you disappointed?"

Namgung Myung thought for a moment, then shook his head and smiled faintly.

"No, I think it's fortunate."

In fact, fortunate?

"If you were really a Transcendent, you would have been in a difficult position in the 'Divine Murim District'."

Divine Murim District.

It seemed to be the new name for the 'First Murim'.

"Because the Divine Murim District doesn't welcome Transcendents."

It was a strange story.

Whether it was the 'New Murim' or the 'Old Murim', if it was a murim, there was no reason to treat Transcendents coldly. If you just achieved the First Stage of Transcendence, you could compete with the lower-ranking Constellations. That's what Transcendents are.

As if he knew my doubts, Namgung Myung opened his mouth again.

"The Transcendents who returned from the Fear Realm are a headache for companies. The Transcendents who are familiar with the laws of the 'Old Murim' are trying to destroy the system instead of adapting to the 'New Murim'."

"I've been wanting to ask you this question since a while ago, but what exactly is this 'company'?"

"Do you know about the Old Murim Faction or the Five Great Sects?"

"Yes. I've heard of it."

The Old Murim Faction and the Five Great Sects.

The Namgung Sect that Namgung Myung was a part of was also one of the Five Great Sects.

"If the past Murim Faction was controlled by the Old Murim Faction and the Five Great Sects, the current New Murim Faction is controlled by 'companies'."

"It's a kind of 'sect'."

"It's similar, but a little different. You'll know when you see it for yourself..."

I thought I knew roughly how the 'New Murim Faction' came to be.

Seeing that they use the word 'company' instead of 'sect', it seems like a similar worldview to the 'Modern Murim Faction' that I used to write about.

"If possible, I recommend that you belong to a 'company'. When you enter the city, you will automatically go up to the examination table, and the examiner will explain the details later."

Just as I was about to ask what the examination table was, a portal opened and a desolate desert appeared. A huge moving walkway was installed in the center of the desert.

We got on the moving walkway.

"The city you see in the distance is the 'New Murim District'."

The exterior of the city was obscured by a white smog as if it had been hit by yellow dust, so I couldn't see it well.

Come to think of it, it was strange that there was a desert area here.

A dry and desolate land.

'Environmental pollution' in that Murim? If Breaking The Sky Sword Saint had seen it, she would have done the same.

As I clicked my tongue inwardly, people began to gather one by one through the other branch of the moving walkway.

I saw one of them waving their hand in this direction.

"Oh, Namgung Myung. This time, you came back safely."

"Hwang Minhyeok."

I looked at the man called Hwang Minhyeok.

He was wearing clothes that were completely different from Namgung Myung, and the words 'Tamra Middle School' were written on his chest.

Is that the name of the company?

When I looked again, there was something written on Namgung Myung's back as well. It was too dusty to read, but Hwang Minhyeok, who was observing Namgung Myung's expression, asked again.

"But where did your team go and are you coming alone?"

"We met waves."

"Waves? Could it be that the entire team was wiped out?"

"A total of thirty-two people, including Yeon Gisu and the supervisor, died."

"Yeon Gisu is fine, but the supervisor died? You, could it be—"

Namgung Myung waved his hand at Hwang Minhyeok, who was glaring.

"I didn't kill him. The supervisor died trying to enter the Middle Zone too hard and fell down."

"Huh, you don't need to make excuses to me. The audit team will find out the details. By the way, who is the incarnation behind you?"

"Oh, this person is…"

Before Namgung Myung could even introduce me, the moving walk began to slow down.

[You will soon enter the 'New Murim District'!]

[You have entered a new scenario area!]

At the same time, I saw my body turning translucent.

Namgung Myung shouted at me urgently.

"Benefactor, I will see you later. And remember! You must choose a company at the judging table! If you don't…!"

Namgung Myung's figure disappeared, and I started to be transferred somewhere. Judging from the feeling, it seemed that I was about to be summoned to that 'examination board'.

Amid the dazzling scenery that was quickly passing by, a message appeared before my eyes like a subway advertisement.

**[Tamra Junggong.]**

—Creating a new world with the bones of forgotten gods.

Tamra Junggong.

The name written on the back of that 'Hwang Minhyeok' earlier.

Was that a company name?

The advertisement kept coming to mind.

**[Vedas Biotech.]**

—Living scripture, rewriting humanity.

The company name in front seems to be the name of the company, and the one after seems to be a slogan.

**[Baekyo Heritage (百妖遺産).]**

—Technologization of the strange, armament of tradition.

I started to understand Namgung Myung's words about choosing a company to belong to.

Is it some kind of sponsor selection?

After all, this 'scenario region' seems to be a system where you enter a 'company' and progress.

In the end, it meant that in order to enter this region, you had to choose one of these companies.

**[Olympus Technology.]**

**[Black Cloud Foundation.]**

…

But as I looked at the passing company names, they all seemed like evil companies.

Olympus Technology?

If I entered a place like that, I'd lose all my stories and live as a slave terminal incarnation for 200 years.

It seemed that each company had a different promotional time, so the companies in the back quickly passed by with only their names introduced.

That was it.

...Huh?

That company passed by 'very quickly'.

But I definitely saw it clearly. That 'company', without a doubt—

> ...
>
> —only we, know the ending of this world.

It was a company I knew very well.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 902 Episode 50 The World After The End (5)

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[■■■ Company.]

I still didn't know whether the word that would go into that ■■■ was Kim Dokja, the name of someone who shouldn't be called, or literally three black squares.

However, there was something certain.

In this crazy worldview, the people who would establish a company with that name were already decided.

'Readers.'

Killer King, Cha Yerin, Kyung Sein, Ji Eunyu, Ye Hyunwoo, Dansu ahjussi...

I could definitely meet all of them, or at least one of them, if I went to that company. I was certain of that.

[The summoning of the examination team is completed.]

The summoning was completed with a dazzling beam of light.

Is this the 'examination team'?

I slowly looked around, and the sight of a pure white room came into view.

The room looked to be about the size of a sports field.

Various weapons were on display outside the examination team. In particular, the quality of the weapons displayed in the front row was quite excellent.

If they are investing this much in just display equipment, is 'Divine Murim District' a fairly wealthy city?

—High-grade D Sword.

—High-grade D Blade.

—High-grade D Spear.

Strangely, all the item names had D in them.

Come to think of it, the coin I received when I entered here also had 'D' in it.

I took out the coin I received as a scenario reward.

**<Item Information>**

Name: D Coin

Grade: ???

Description: A special currency circulated in 'Divine Murim District'. It has relatively high value compared to regular coins. There are rumors that it contains the stories of 'Divine Beings of the Otherworld' found in places like the 'Fear Realm', and there are cases where unrefined 'Fears' are sometimes found, so be careful when handling it.

That was a simple explanation. Expensive currency handled in this area.

Anyway, Divine Beings of the Otherworld... The moment I held the coin, I felt an unpleasant sensation, as if I had touched the skin of an unfamiliar creature.

['D Coin' responds to your story.]

In an instant, the coin clung to my palm like a leech. I was startled and summoned the coin back.

I guess it's because I've been back to the scenario for the first time in 8 years, but I can't get used to everything from the currency to the scenario area.

If I could contact them at least, I'd ask for help, but it doesn't seem like the inside of the [Fourth Wall] would be a good situation.

I should meet the readers quickly.

"Is anyone here?"

There was no sign of anyone around the examination table except for me.

Why is there no one here? Is this an automated system?

I thought about just walking out, but I remembered Namgung Myung's advice to definitely choose a company.

Let's wait a little longer.

I took out 'Unbreakable Faith' and started to lightly stretch my body. Maybe because it was a Murim area, the amount of magical power in the air was quite abundant.

[Exclusive trait, 'Circulation Delay', is activated!]

Lightly draw a sword line left and right.

Although I didn't become a Transcendent, my swordsmanship skills have improved by leaps and bounds since joining the 'Transcendent Alliance' and completing the 1,863rd Round. The connection between [Way of the Wind] and [Baekcheong-ganggi] has become much more natural, and my understanding of the characters in [Bookmark] has also improved significantly.

Honestly, I felt like I wouldn't lose to any incarnation except for Yoo Joonghyuk right now.

"Huh?"

That was when I discovered the sword mark drawn in the middle of the martial arts field.

The sword mark that tore the solid martial arts field floor diagonally.

'It's the martial arts of the Transcendents.'

There was no doubt about it. Judging from the strength of the floor and the depth of the sword, it was a powerful Transcendent that had reached at least the 3rd stage of Transcendence.

The faces of the Transcendent Alliance quickly flashed through my mind.

Did one of them visit here? But it wasn't Cheok Jungyeong's [Three Swords] or Kyrgios' [Baekcheong-ganggi]. At first glance, it seemed like [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship], but upon closer inspection, it had different characteristics.

There was another strange thing. The moment I examined the form of the swordsmanship, my heart fluttered slightly. I can't express it well, but it seemed like the swordsman who left this sword mark swung a sword in extreme sadness.

"Huh? Who is it?"

A voice was heard from the entrance outside the examination hall. The one who opened the entrance and came in was a middle-aged man wearing somewhat baggy clothes.

A person finally appeared.

It seemed that the middle-aged man was the 'examiner'.

"Who is Young Hero?"

"I'm here to be examined."

"Alone?"

"Yes."

The middle-aged man looked at something on the terminal he took out from his bosom as if he was embarrassed, and then said.

"That's strange. The lower scenarios aren't in the season for the promotion yet, right?"

What kind of a baseless term is the season of the quest?

"How did you get here, Young Hero?"

"I walked."

"Huh?"

"I just walked into the city and got summoned here."

The middle-aged man who had been listening to my answer with a blank expression suddenly snapped.

"Hey you! Don't lie! How can someone who walked into the city get summoned to the examination?"

"It happened?"

The middle-aged man looked extremely embarrassed. I felt his lips mumble softly as he rolled his eyes and examined me for a moment.

I guess I know what he's trying to do.

[Someone has activated 'Precise Search'!]

However, there was no way he could deduce my identity with such a skill.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is activating!]

With a light spark, the examiner who was watching me was greatly shocked and took a step back.

"What, what is this—"

Then, he opened his eyes wide and began to examine my entire body. It was probably not a 'perception' skill, but rather an attempt to read my status through his senses.

But it would be useless.

This 'hood' I'm wearing was taken from the last scenario area.

[Your status is hidden by the effect of the item, 'Unidentified Hood'.]

The examiner looked at me with a confused expression, and suddenly spoke to me formally.

"Young Hero, are you by any chance from the 'Giant Nebula'?"

'Giant Nebula'.

Come to think of it, I had once made a Small Nebula at the 'Recycling Center' with other readers.

"It's not a Giant Nebula."

"But how... No, wait a minute."

The tone of his speech changed immediately when I told him I wasn't from a Giant Nebula.

While the examiner was going through a stack of electronic documents, I lightly activated my skill toward the examiner in front of me.

[Exclusive skill, 'Character List' activated!]

**<Character Information>**

Name: Jeon Yeongwoo

Age: 231

Sponsor: None (Currently, there is no Constellation interested).

…

I doubted my eyes for a moment.

It was because it had been a long time since I had seen an ordinary incarnation that was over 100 years old.

Did I enter a 'Time Fault'?

Exclusive Traits: 2nd Class Examiner (Rare), Cyborg (Rare), Lobby Expert (Rare).

Exclusive Skill: [Heartless Sword Technique Lv. 10]

Overall Ability: [Physical Strength Lv. 67], [Strength Lv. 88], [Agility Lv. 84], [Magic Power Lv. 68]

Overall Evaluation: Jeon Yeongwoo is an examiner of the 'New Murim' equipped with a low-level foreign body. Jeon Yeongwoo, who has been dealing with major companies in 'New Murim' for a long time, maintains close connections with Executive-level figures in the companies.

'Foreign body. Cyborg. That's why they have long lives.'

Come to think of it, there was a time when a large number of similar incarnations appeared in 'Ways of Survival'.

It was the 1,500th Round, I think.

I skimmed through it so I don't remember clearly, but the scenario area. Some were occupied by a group called a 'company'.

The Murim world including 'First Murim', the world of the demons, and even the medieval fantasy world and SF world including 'Peace Land'.

「The appearance of a company that governs the mid-level scenario area where incarnations reside in large numbers.」

Maybe those 'companies' are the 'companies' I checked earlier.

And this examiner...

"Hmm, are you really a friendly person who came up without knowing anything? It's been a while since I've seen something like this."

He was a kind of a 'new recruit training manager' who was in charge of measuring the skills of the incarnations and transferring them to a company.

"I guess they don't usually come in walking like me?"

"The judging panel only summons incarnations who have come up through [the path to the top] from lower scenarios. They won't be summoned to this 'judging panel' just because they walked into the city."

Is that the principle?

"Usually, the 'judging' is conducted according to the season branches of the lower scenarios. This season already ended a few months ago, so I thought there wouldn't be any new recruits for a while..."

So this 'judging panel' is a kind of primary filtering net that welcomes new recruits who come up to the 'new Murim district' through [the path to the top] from lower scenarios.

"If you're summoned to the 'judging panel' alone at a time like this, it's usually one of two things. You're either an 'outcast' who has been away from the scenarios for a long time, or..."

The judge, who was looking at me with deep eyes, continued speaking.

"A mysterious strong man who suddenly 'jumped from a scenario' in an unknown scenario, or Young Hero?"

I thought for a moment and then asked.

"Is there a disadvantage if I don't answer properly?"

"Hehe, what an interesting newcomer. You're really spirited."

"First of all, I'm not an outcast."

"I guess so. If you're an outcast, your incarnation body should have already been dyed in the probability aftermath."

Were there some outcasts hiding in the scenario?

The examiner seemed to know a lot about the characteristics of outcasts.

"Then you're from a lower scenario... There's something about it that doesn't make sense to believe that."

"What's the point?"

"Usually, when you're summoned here from a lower scenario, you can't help but have trouble breathing because of the narrative pressure of the higher scenario, but Young Hero is very relaxed."

The density of the stories that could be felt in the air was definitely different. But compared to the density of the stories I experienced in the 'Fear Realm', this level of pressure was child's play.

"Even if you've come this far, there must be a last scenario you cleared. What's the last scenario number?"

Which scenario was the last?

The last scenario I performed was the 'Fear Realm', but the Fear Realm didn't have a scenario number.

Then should I start from the 'Recycling Center' before that?

"It's probably around scenario number 20."

The examiner's eyes widened after hearing me.

"No way! Do you know which scenario this is?"

I nodded. Even without asking, there had been a message flashing above my head since a while ago.

[You have currently entered the 'Scenario 70' area.]

[The main scenario will be assigned soon.]

Scenario 70.

A number that wouldn’t be strange even if a 'Giant Story Scenario' of the Super-Large Nebulae occurs.

At this point, the examiner’s shock was understandable. Even after looking through both the 'main story' and the 'Ways of Survival', there was no incarnation that suddenly jumped 50 scenarios.

"Did you receive the blessing of a Constellation of a Narrative or a Myth grade?"

"Hmm, I think there was something like that."

"Did you learn from the Transcendent Alliance’s Transcendents, or were you their disciple?"

Strictly speaking, I was a disciple, but I didn’t learn their martial arts.

Strictly speaking, I didn’t learn martial arts from them, I was a thief who stole with [Bookmarks].

"Huh… Either way, it’s surprising. Honestly, the level I feel from the small group isn’t that great…"

The examiner licked his lips after saying that and started sending a message somewhere. I guess he was sending a message to a 'company'.

As I was looking at that scene, a familiar cliché came to mind.

That's it.

The 'rank measurement episode' that is often seen in hunter stories.

This is the cliché that hunters who returned from 'another world' or 'rank measurement impossible' dungeons experience when they visit the Hunter Association.

Usually, character A, who ignores me, should appear around this time.

[The Constellation, 'Master of White Deer Lake', is curious about your strength.]

Unfortunately, there was no such sign.

I was wondering whether I should maintain 'exhausted mode' this time as well or whether it would be better to gradually show off my strength, but the examiner said something unexpected.

"Oh, really, I really want to measure the rank of Young Hero, but unfortunately, the measuring machine is broken right now. Last time, one of the incarnations summoned destroyed all the spare measuring machines."

To be honest, from my perspective, it wasn't such a bad situation. It was like I had a reasonable excuse to hide my strength. However, I was a little curious about who the incarnation was that destroyed all the extra 'measuring devices'.

I absentmindedly glanced at the bottom of the examination table.

Could the owner of the 'mark' be that incarnation?

"If you're an executive, they can tell your rank without a measuring device…"

The examiner, who had been thinking for a moment, gestured toward me as if he had made up his mind.

"Well, that's better. Please follow me for a moment."

"Where are we going?"

"There's an 'Ascension Ceremony' for corporate executives scheduled to take place near here today."

"Ascension ceremony?"

"To put it simply, it's the day when the executives go up to the 'next scenario' area. Normally, a newbie like you can't attend this event…"

If you're an executive, it probably means someone who has a big responsibility in the company.

"I think it's great that you came all the way here alone, so I'll take you there for a special occasion."

I looked at the examiner who was smiling shamelessly as if he was doing me a great favor.

There was no reason for the examiner I met for the first time today to suddenly be kind to me, so his intention was clear.

「Some of the companies he just contacted want to contact me.」

In other words, this guy was plotting to sell me off to a company in real time.

Did he judge me to be that valuable?

[Your understanding of the character 'Lobbying Expert Jeon Yeongwoo' has increased!]

If I wasn't careful, I could have been sold off to the losers of this region as soon as I started the scenario.

In order to maintain the wise 'strength mode', it would have been right to sneak away at this point, but I was also curious.

Just how strong do the key figures in this 'scenario region' really are? And how strong have I become now?

That's when a strange story became entangled in my feelings.

"Examiner."

I stopped walking, looked at the doorway outside the examination room, and asked,

"Do you happen to know who the 'Executive' who is ascending today is?"

The owner of a story I knew very well was definitely there.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 903 Episode 50 The World After The End (6)

Did my question sound strange?

The examiner, whose expression had changed, looked at me carefully.

Did I say something wrong? It doesn't seem like such a big question to be curious about who the Ascendant is today.

"Hmm, now that I think about it, you said you received the blessing of a higher Constellation. I guess you're curious if there's anyone you know among the Ascendants."

I nodded.

If you misunderstand, I'd be grateful.

The examiner, who had been pondering for a moment, answered.

"Ascendants are usually from large corporations. They're the incarnations who were considered promising talents when they first joined the company. Let's see. Today's Ascendants are from <Tamra Heavy Industries>, <Black Cloud Foundation>, and <Olympus Technology>…"

Tamra Heavy Industries. Black Cloud Foundation. Olympus Technology. They were all company names named after famous Nebulae. Tamra would be <Tamra> based on Jeju

folktales, and Black Cloud would be <Black Cloud> of the Black Flame Dragon. <Olympus>… there's no need to mention it.

Why did companies named after Nebulae enter 'Murim'?

Was it because of the power struggle related to the destroyed Fear Realm? Or maybe there was a need to supplement the Incarnation resources in the lower scenarios…

In either case, it wasn't a good scenario flow. Especially if a Nebula, who wasn't particularly interested in expanding their power like <Black Cloud>, had also intervened… something big that I don't know about could have happened in the upper scenarios.

"…So, today's list of Ascendants… Hmm? Oh, where did I save the list…"

While the examiner was hurriedly searching through the documents, a door leading to the Ascension Ceremony location appeared in the distance.

This is difficult. If the Ascendant over there is related to the 'being' I'm thinking of…

"How strong are the Executives?"

"Oh, right. I wonder about that too."

It's a scenario in the 70s.

Considering that even the main story's <Gigantomachia> was a scenario in the 60s, the Ascendants in the 70s must be incredibly strong.

"Don't be surprised. The Executives have a 'level' that's equivalent to the early stage of Narrative grade."

Early stage of Narrative grade.

Even the guys like 'Master of Spears' that we fought against at the 'Recycling Center' before were, strictly speaking, early stage of Narrative grade.

However, back then, it was a scenario in the 20s, and now it's a scenario in the 70s.

Since the binding force of the probability that can handle the maximum level of the level is different, even the same 'early stage of Narrative grade' will exert completely different power here.

"I see."

"Hmm? You're not really surprised."

I answered with a grin and stared ahead.

Now, what kind of guy is beyond here? Is he related to the 'existence' that I thought of?

"Now, this is the Ascension Hall where the Ascension Ceremony is held."

Along with the judge's introduction, a wide, circular platform appeared.

A vast sky reminiscent of a celestial sphere hung on the ceiling, and a translucent passage of light descended from the center of the sky and connected the platform. It was a sight reminiscent of an Orbital Elevator.

"Ohhh—!"

In addition to us, hundreds of incarnations had gathered in the area.

"Blood Jade Demon! Blood Jade Demon!"

Incarnations whose ranks were comparable to the judge next to me. If they were the incarnations who survived until now, they must be worthy of it.

—The Ascension Ceremony will be held today.

It seems that this 'Ascension Ceremony' is a large-scale event in the 'New Murim District'.

The faces of the Ascendants were shown in close-up on the giant screen displayed at the top of the platform.

The judge next to me sighed as if he had just remembered.

"Today is the Ascension Ceremony of Jo Daehyeop."

[NOTE 1]

"Jo Daehyeop?"

"The incarnation standing on the right side of the altar is none other than Jo Jincheol, the Blood Jade Demon."

Jo Jincheol.

It was a name I knew.

"Jo Daehyeop is an Ascendant of the <Black Cloud Foundation>. Hehe, how many martial artists have had their spines ripped out by Jo Daehyeop in the past few years?"

At that moment, I could hear the mutterings of the onlookers nearby.

"The troublemaker of Murim is finally ascending to the upper town."

"That vicious bastard."

I glared at the face on the screen and frowned.

That 'Jo Jincheol' survived up to scenario number 70?

The head of the Gyeonggi Alliance, the Ten Evils Jo Jincheol.

In the main story, I know he was defeated by Kim Dokja in the Demon King Promotion Match and died, but how on earth did he end up here? Oh, I see, there is no such 'Kim Dokja' in this world...

Judging by the 'Black Cloud Foundation' written on his back, Jo Jincheol seemed to be an Ascendant of the <Black Cloud> side.

"Paradise Emperor! Paradise Emperor!"

"Ohhh!"

The next Ascendant to be illuminated was a tall, slender figure with small horns on his head.

The moment I heard his nickname, I got goosebumps.

Is this some kind of special on the Ten Evils?

I knew that the 41st Round was going to be a terrible Round, but I didn't know it would be this bad.

If Yoo Joonghyuk was here, he'd be all beat to death.

The owner of Paradise, Reinheit.

Reinheit, who should have fallen down dead in the 9th scenario, was standing there, looking fine.

How on earth did he bring the guy who was stuck in Paradise?

No... Wait a minute.

「The 'Dark Castle' that was the 8th scenario didn't appear on the Korean Peninsula in this Round.」

Originally, 'Reinheit' was the villain who was killed by Yoo Joonghyuk in the Dark Castle.

Since Yoo Joonghyuk, who was going to destroy it, didn't visit the Dark Castle, it was natural development for him to survive in this Round.

The intensity felt from Reinheit's entire body was almost on par with that of a lower-level Demon King.

On his back was written <Olympus Technology>.

Kukukuku.

I don't know the details of this round, but the fact that he came here must mean that he had a powerful benefit that was enough to throw away 'Paradise'.

The moment I saw the spear held in his right hand, I thought I knew what benefit he had received.

"That's—!"

The screams of the incarnations in amazement.

Surprisingly, in his hand was Astrape, a sacred relic of Zeus.

"Thunderbolt's Left Thunderbolt!"

"It's as powerful as I've heard!"

If that were real, I would have been surprised and fallen over.

However, I've seen Zeus swing the Thunderbolt himself several times. So I was sure of it.

"It's a well-made fake."

The examiner flinched and turned to me.

"You have a keen eye. That's right."

"It seems to be equivalent to a Holy Relic."

"It's proof that the Paradise Emperor is recognized by <Olympus> to that extent. Even if it's a mass-produced version, not just anyone can have that spear."

"I see."

I don't know the specific method, but it was clear that Reinheit escaped the Dark Castle with the support of <Olympus>.

Yoo Joonghyuk had also accepted Reinheit as a colleague, so <Olympus>'s decision was understandable.

Anyway, the fact that they've made it to the 70th main scenario means that the lower scenario regions that I knew of were already...

「As we enter the latter half of the scenarios, some continents on Earth have disappeared from the map forever.」

A sinister thought came to mind along with the phrase from 'Ways of Survival' that came to mind.

Will the Korean Peninsula be safe?

What happened to the incarnations at Geumho Station and Gwanghwamun?

"I thought there was one more Ascendant, but it seems he hasn't arrived yet. That's for the best. Follow me. The full-fledged Ascension Ceremony is not over yet, so I have some time to spare."

The examiner said that and moved through the crowd toward the altar.

I thought about sneaking out at this point, but since I had come this far, there was one thing I wanted to try.

"Jo Daehyeop!"

Jo Jincheol turned to look at the examiner's call. It seemed that Jo Jincheol knew the examiner.

"Oh, Jeon Daein."

"Congratulations. You are finally leaving this damn 'New Murim'."

"Thank you. I guess we are meant to be. It's because we met again on the last day."

Jo Jincheol, who had no influence in the main story, became a being on par with 'Narrative-grade'.

Based on the sense of stories, it seemed that he had reached the early Narrative-grade by increasing the average synchronization rate with his sponsor, but even that wasn't easy.

"Haha, that's right. I heard that you secured quite a lot of D Coins in the recent 'Foreign Press Suppression War'."

"Hmm, nothing much. Just took care of a few remnants of the Disaster-level."

"As expected, you're the great Jo Daehyeop."

Watching Jo Jincheol converse so normally, I felt a sense of wonder inside.

Perhaps this was an extremely rare scene in the entire 'Ways of Survival'.

「I want to record it.」

[The 'Recorder of Fear', whose identity has not been revealed, looks around in surprise.]

Did he sense my gaze?

Jo Jincheol glanced back at me. When the examiner pointed to me and explained the situation, Jo Jincheol's eyes flashed with interest.

"A subject for irregular examination?"

"Yes. He's the incarnation that entered the 'New Murim District' today."

"Hmm... Aren't you a friendly soldier who's reluctant to reveal your face?"

At that tone of voice asking how I could be so arrogant as to wear my hood upside down in front of the victor, I took off my hood with a bitter smile.

[The effect of the item, 'Unidentified Hood' disappears.]

"Hoo..."

Jo Jincheol's eyes flashed. An unpleasant gaze scanned my face. What he used wasn't a search or insight skill.

I knew the skill Jo Jincheol used.

「Those who have reached the early stages of the Narrative-grade acquire their own 'story interpretation method'.」

'Narrative' is both the status of a Constellation and the way Constellations view the world.

Every Constellation emits light based on the stories it has accumulated, and understands the world by projecting that light onto other stories.

That's why the 'birth story' is important to all Constellations.

This was the same for not only Constellations, but also for Transcendents. For example, those who have reached the third stage of the Transcendents could understand others' stories and even infer their hidden realm.

Jo Jincheol, who was in front of me now, also seemed to have manifested the same power as he entered the early stages of Narrative-grade.

I had a conversation with Han Sooyoung about this once.

「"You mean the hood won't work from the early stages of the Narrative-grade?"」

「"They have excellent story detection."」

「"Then how can I hide my identity in front of the Narrative-grade?"」

Han Sooyoung smiled and answered my question.

「"Don't do anything."」

「"Yes?"」

「"Now the average Constellation won't be able to guess your realm?"」

Jo Jincheol's expression was changing in real time before my eyes.

"This is?"

"Jo Daehyeop. Do you see something?"

"Hmm."

「"Why?"」

「"I don't know if you don't realize it or if you want to show off. Think about the stories you've built up so far."」

I thought about the stories I had 'built' myself.

Recorder of Things that Will Disappear (사라질 것들의 기록자).

The One Who Rewrote Fate (운명을 다시 쓰는 자).

Heir of the Eternal Name (영원한 이름의 계승자).

The Line Between Truth and Lies (진실과 거짓의 행간).

Up until this point, three were legendary, and one was mythical.

And on top of that, there was the 'Giant Tale' that had no name yet.

「"Huh?"」

「"Do you understand now?"」

I have built more than five 'stories' so far.

And the <Star Stream> describes the existence that has built five stories as follows.

Constellation.

Originally, I should have already achieved the status of a Constellation.

But the <Star Stream> and the Management Bureau did not give me the modifier of a Constellation.

Why on earth?

「"It must be because of the 'rank' of the stories you have built."」

Come to think of it, even 'Kim Dokja' did not build stories of this level when he became a Constellation.

King of a Kingless World (왕이 없는 세계의 왕).

One Who Fights Against Fate (이적에 맞서는 자).

One Who Hunted the King of Disasters (재앙의 왕을 사냥한 자).

One Who Killed an Outer God (이계의 신격을 살해한 자).

Demon King of Salvation (구원의 마왕).

Four Legendary-level stories and one Semi-Myth-grade stories.

「"That 'Kim Dokja' also received a 'Narrative-grade Constellation' as his first rank. But if you were to receive a rank, what would you become?"」

I couldn't answer.

「"The Management Bureau judged after seeing the stories you've accumulated. 'That can't possibly be possible. That kind of being is definitely an 'error.'"」

An 'error' that is not given a rank.

「"The Constellations just use a handful of light to read whatever they want to read."」

Han Sooyoung's smiling expression slowly overlapped with Jo Jincheol's in front of her.

The Narrative-grade Constellation was looking at me through Jo Jincheol's swirling eyes.

「"I'm curious too. In those guys' eyes, what will you 'look like' now?"」

Jo Jincheol's lips opened.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Daehyeop 대협 = 'Grand Master Martial Artist', as opposed to Young Hero/Sohyeop 소협 which means Young Expert Martial Artist.

# 904 Episode 50 The World After The End (7)

"Demon King?"

The judge's expression was expressed by Jo Jincheol's one word.

"Jo Daehyeop! What do you mean, Demon King?"

"With your tongue... you fooled people?"

"Tongue, with his tongue? Is there a Demon King related to the tongue?"

As the incarnations in the audience began to get curious one by one, Jo Jincheol's mouth continued to move.

"...A new world requires new laws."

Huh?

"I'll knock you all out of that damn sky!"

Huh?

"... I have my own life?"

Wait a minute. Is this kid reading the original story?

"What the hell are you talking about, Jo Daehyeop. What kind of being is this newbie?"

Jo Jincheol answered in a deep breath.

"Amazing. I think I only have a few stories of Historical-grade, but if there is a person who has this kind of story, then he might be the talent our ancestors were looking for."

"If it's our ancestors..."

"The great master of <Black Cloud>!"

"Whoa!"

Looking at the examiner who fell over in surprise, I briefly wondered if this might be some kind of surprise newcomer party.

"On the planet I lived on, there were guys with a trait called 'middle school syndrome'. A devilish talent that pushed their delusions to the limit and eventually made them a reality..."

As I listened to the story, I vaguely thought I knew what Jo Jincheol had seen in me.

「"Most Constellations that see you will probably experience cognitive dissonance. It will be hard to accept that someone who is neither a Constellation nor a Transcendental Constellation has such a strangely great status.」

If they acknowledge you, the Constellations will have to accept that an incarnation that is nothing is stronger than them.

So ordinary Constellations will not be able to face your existence and will only read fragments of distorted stories."」

Is that why she was curious about what other Constellations would see in me?

I was about to tell them that it was a complete misunderstanding, but Jo Jincheol, whose eyes had changed, shouted at me excitedly.

"Come to our <Black Cloud Foundation>. With your talent, I can contact the foundation's main server right now and help you download [Black Flame Sky Dance]."

Black Flame Sky Dance. It's a martial art that I don't want to learn just by hearing its name.

But the others seemed to have different thoughts.

"The <Black Cloud Foundation> made the first offer to recruit him?"

"Black Flame Sky! Oh my goodness. Isn't that the unique martial arts of the <Black Cloud Foundation> Executives?"

"He's a really enviable new recruit."

The situation was taking a strange turn.

The examiner lightly tapped my shoulder and said.

"You're really lucky. Judging from your expression, I don't think you understand what's going on yet, but this is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity."

"..."

"Black Cloud Foundation is one of the 'big corporations in the New Murim District. If you can ascend through that company, your future will be..."

I was about to say that it didn't seem like a very positive future, but then I heard the people around me talking.

"Damn, another parachute has appeared. You damned Constellation-spooners."

"I'm jealous, though."

The expressions were filled with envy and jealousy.

Listening to the rumbling voices, my mood became complicated for no reason. Perhaps the possibility of incarnation is mostly determined by the first scenario, 'Proof of Value'.

The incarnations who survived until now without receiving proper sponsor selection still have to endure life waiting for the selection of the higher Constellations.

"Damn it. If only I could go to a large company..."

In the main story, Kim Dokja became a Constellation on his own without sponsor selection, but not everyone can take that path.

I was worried about my colleagues again. Even if it was true that Dansu ahjussi and Ji Eunyu-ssi were selected by Narrative-grade Constellations, what would have happened to the other colleagues who did not choose at the sponsor selection?

The examiner patted my shoulder again and said.

"...So, if you enter the <Black Cloud Foundation> and polish your stories for about ten years, you can become an ascendant like Jo Daehyeop and become a dragon who assists the great Black Cloud Master. Do you know what kind of being the Black Cloud Master is?"

"I've heard of it."

"That's right. Haha, you can't help but know. He's closer to the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse' than any other existing dragon!"

In short, if you join there and suffer for ten years, you can become the Black Flame Dragon's footstool.

This human, if he knew that I was chosen by the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' in the first scenario's sponsor selection, he'd probably faint.

I was about to express my intention to refuse without hesitation, but unfortunately someone interrupted me.

"Why are you having such a pleasant conversation without me?"

It was Paradise Emperor Reinheit.

Jo Jincheol, sensing something strange, quickly blocked his way and warned him.

"Paradise Emperor, it's not your place to interfere. Our <Black Cloud Foundation> has already decided to recruit this cute guy."

"I don't think you've heard that incarnation's opinion yet?"

"There's no need to listen! What kind of incarnation would dare to refuse to be recruited by the Foundation!"

"It seems you've already forgotten about the Mad Sword Emperor incident."

Jo Jincheol's expression hardened.

"Mad Sword Emperor! Why are you bringing up that crazy woman?"

"Even back then, didn't Jo Daehyeop misread the story and recklessly try to recruit her, and the Foundation branch was almost destroyed?"

"You!"

"Please give me a chance too. Maybe he's a better fit for <Olympus Technology> than <Black Cloud Foundation>?"

Reinheit ignored the indignant Jo Jincheol and turned his ominous eyes toward me.

"Hmm..."

The guy unleashed the power of the Constellation and began to read my stories. It was the exact method Jo Jincheol had used.

I wondered what kind of strange things I would hear this time.

"It's amazing. Even that 'Flame Demon Emperor Star' wouldn't have been able to build such a noble story in a scenario of the same level…"

The examiner was surprised by Reinheit's words and asked again.

"Have you ever seen Flame Demon Emperor Star?"

"I've seen them once from afar. They're as beautiful as the rumors say. I couldn't get close because of the tale of the Monkey King…"

The Monkey King?

It sounds like a story about someone I know.

"Anyway, it's been a long time since I've seen an incarnation come up here with such a clear soul."

At that moment, Reinheit's [Echo] came into my ear.

—Excuse me, which great Demon King's household are you?

Hmm?

"He's the one who saved countless souls and built up good stories."

When I glared at him, he continued [Echo] with a deep smile.

—Although I can't read your essence, I can strongly sense the tale of 'hypocrisy' from you. Hoho, how many beings have you deceived?

Look at this kid?

"Unless you've received the grace of an Archangel, it would be difficult to build such a good story…"

—With this level of sorcery, you must have deceived countless Constellations to get here. Above all, your narrow eyes that even this power cannot see through…

The attendees of the ascension ceremony stirred once again.

"The grace of an Archangel? Is he from <Eden>?"

"But <Eden> wouldn't have opened a branch in the 'New Murim District'—"

"You can only have an incarnation that has received grace. Either way, it's a great thing."

Before long, the whole place was filled with stories about me.

Taking advantage of the atmosphere, Reinheit made a suggestion.

"Come to our <Olympus Technology>."

—I don't know why you left the Demon World and came here… but if a high-ranking Demon King's agent came here, it means there must be some unavoidable circumstance. <Olympus> can protect you. Even if you are being chased by <Eden>.

It seemed like he had a huge misunderstanding about me.

He must have judged me to be a high-ranking Demon King who was expelled from the Demon World or something similar…

Thinking about it carefully, it was unfair that I couldn’t say it was a misunderstanding.

In the meantime, Jo Jincheol intervened again.

"What nonsense are you talking about, Reinheit! You said you only followed the goddess of beauty around, but now your eyes have become distorted. Archangel? A good story? Where can you read stories like that from this guy! This guy is a talent of the 'Black

Cloud Foundation'! Hey, ignore that nonsense! I'll write a letter of recommendation myself!"

"A-a letter of recommendation from an Ascendant!"

I don't know much about letters of recommendation, but it seems to be a great privilege here.

The examiner nodded happily as if he had read my expression and explained.

"You're still a newbie, so you don't know much, but if you get a letter of recommendation and join, you should be able to become eligible for Ascension in at least 5 years depending on your efforts. Even if you learn [Black Flame Spring]…!"

In short, it was a story that the time it would take to become the Black Flame Dragon's footstool would be shortened from 10 years to 5 years.

What an incredible benefit.

I was about to readily express my intention to decline, but this time Reinheit intervened.

"If you join our <Olympus Technology>, we will put you on the Ascension Platform within 3 years."

"3 years! Oh my god!"

I smiled bitterly.

I don't know for sure, but there must be a heated debate going on inside the [Fourth Wall] about 'Becoming an Olympus Slave vs. Becoming a Black Flame Dragon Footstool' right now.

"It doesn't end here. If you become an Ascendant, I will personally recommend you as the incarnation of the Twelve Gods of <Olympus>."

The room was filled with shock. Olympus's Twelve Seats.

If I didn't know much about <Olympus>, it would have been a tempting suggestion.

"Oh my! Is the Paradise Emperor sincere?"

"If it's the Paradise Emperor, then it's possible. I heard that the Paradise Emperor was also selected as an incarnation candidate for one of the Twelve Seats this time."

This time, I was a little surprised.

That Reinheit is the incarnation of one of the Twelve Seats?

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

I instinctively felt wary.

If Reinheit was a terminal incarnation directly connected to the <Olympus> Twelve Seats, then this situation was dangerous.

<Olympus> had clashed with me several times in the 'Recycling Center' and the 'Fear Realm'. Even if it had been quite some time, if it was a Twelve Seats-level, they might recognize my identity.

At that moment, the sky above the Ascension Platform was rippling ominously. Intermittent sparks began to flow around Reinheit's brainwashing window.

I quickly turned my hood over and asked.

"Excuse me, but I have a different company I would like to join."

The examiner, startled by my words, asked.

"Huh? What do you mean?"

I looked around the room. The incarnations gathered here were each wearing uniforms with different company symbols or names on them. However, no matter how much I searched, I couldn't find the company name I was looking for.

"You're crazy. You're looking for another company when you have the ascendants of <Black Cloud Foundation> and <Olympus Technology> right in front of you?"

"Are you a kid who still can't see?"

If I was going to be the Black Flame Dragon's footstool or the terminal incarnation of <Olympus> in the first place, I wouldn't have gone through all that trouble and come this far.

While everyone else was making expressions of bewilderment, only Reinheit was looking at me with profound eyes.

"Interesting. You rejected <Black Cloud Foundation> and <Olympus Technology> and chose the 'third option'? Somehow, a famous anecdote comes to mind."

"Heh heh. Keuhahahaha!"

Jo Jincheol burst into laughter as well. I wondered what was so funny about my answer. Then, Jo Jincheol stopped laughing for a moment and looked at me.

"You, do you think you can be a 'Kim Dokja'?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 905 Episode 50 The World After The End (8)

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Kim Dokja.

I stopped for a moment at that unexpected name.

Why did that name come out of Jo Jincheol's mouth? Did the name 'Kim Dokja' become famous without me knowing?

Looking back, the identity of the 'Kim Dokja fragments' was revealed even among the general incarnations, so it wasn't strange that the name itself became known.

This is what's really strange.

「How do the ascended ones know that 'Kim Dokja chooses the third option'?」

Of course, I've made similar choices a few times, but I don't think my story would have been known to people like that.

Then how do the two beings in front of me know that story?

No way...

"Haha, stop joking, Jo Daehyeop."

"Ah, that must have been too big of a 'name' for a newbie."

My heart sank.

Could it be that there was another being who impersonated 'Kim Dokja' while I was away?

"You never know. 'That' also suddenly appeared in the middle of the scenario, so this newbie might end up writing the same legend. In that sense…"

Reinheit, who was smiling brightly, added while pointing his finger into the distance.

"Kim Dokja's 'third option' is coming over there."

The third option.

The moment I turned around, Reinheit said.

"However, prospective Kim Dokja, I'm giving you some advice in advance. Your 'third option' will be the 'worst option' in this city at least."

I felt the air around the area change along with the eerie feeling. I could feel a strange master approaching from behind. The two ascenders in front of me were strong enough, but the being approaching me now was stronger than all of them combined. Even without any intention of hiding their momentum, the incarnations of the group complained of difficulty breathing as they approached.

Jo Jincheol frowned and pointed.

"I-I...!"

My instincts were warning me. It wasn't simply because the presence behind me was 'strong'.

Some kind of unpleasant sensation was spreading through my entire body.

Wait, could this story be...?

"Hahahaha! I finally found it!"

A voice that felt familiar madness.

The judge said. There were three ascenders today.

One was Jo Jincheol of <Black Cloud Foundation>, and the other was Reinheit of <Olympus Technology>.

And now, behind me, the third 'Ascendant' was standing.

"Supreme King! You're here!"

A cold hand wrapped around my shoulder.

I slowly turned around and saw the large <Tamra Heavy Industries> symbol drawn in front of him.

"I didn't expect to meet you here...! Huh? What is this?"

The eyes of the Ascendant who saw my face widened.

This is difficult. Who would have thought I would meet this guy here?

A beautiful face with a more neutral face than Reinheit. A legendary madman from <Star Stream> who only follows 'Yoo Joonghyuk' around all day long.

"What? Who are you...?"

The leader of the Salvation Church, Nirvana Mobius.

I lightly shook his hand off.

"I thought you passed away in Washington East, but you're still alive."

"Huh, do you think I'd die in a place like that?"

Well, Nirvana had an emergency escape device, the stigma [No Possession].

"No, but how do you know that I left? Were you the guy who was there?"

It seemed like Nirvana didn't remember my face. I started to be active in the Washington Dome after Nirvana collapsed.

"You, that squint... Are you 'that guy'? No, no, there’s no way he could have survived this Round? But this story…"

Nirvana’s eyes narrowed for a moment.

Maybe he read the tale of 'Cheon Inho'?

But if Anna Croft’s words were true, Nirvana had never met 'Cheon Inho' in the previous Round.

Nirvana’s eyes, which had been shining anxiously, quickly changed.

"Well, that’s okay. It doesn't matter who you are."

Nirvana, who was laughing, grabbed my shoulder once again.

"What matters is the 'story' you have."

Story?

I hurriedly looked back at the story fragment shining on my shoulder.

And only then did I understand what Nirvana was so excited about.

[Story fragment 'Mad Soldier Yoo Joonghyuk' expresses his hatred towards the Reincarnater!]

Damn, I had this story fragment.

Nirvana, smiling brightly, shouted.

"Become one with this body!"

A spinning mandala appeared behind Nirvana.

"Kuaaaaak! The Ascendant has gone mad!"

"Everyone, get out of here!"

The incarnations who sensed the omen of the attack began to run away in terror.

"Oh, you're going to do something after all."

When Reinheit sighed as if he had expected this, the examiner shouted urgently.

"Start the Ascension Ceremony quickly! At this rate, that newbie will be eaten!"

"Ah, the heavens haven't opened yet. If the Orbital Elevator is to come down—"

It seems like it will take some time until the Ascension Ceremony.

That means I will have to see blood here in the end.

I nervously pulled up the stories all over my body, but unexpectedly, there was a strong ally blocking my way.

"Stop, Salvation Leader. I chose this newbie first."

Jo Jincheol, Blood Jade Sword Demon.

"Haven't you already become 'one' with enough incarnations? I can't even hand over this 'irregular' examinee to you."

And then Paradise Emperor Reinheit blocked me as if protecting me.

Honestly, I was touched.

I never thought I'd see three villains brawling over me.

[An unnamed 'Recorder of Fear' shows interest.]

[A small number of 'Recorders of Fear' show interest in the case.]

An indirect message from the 'Recorders of Fear' heard from the air.

Is it because I too am qualified to be a 'Recorder of Fear' that I can hear it so clearly?

Then can I say something like that? What kind of abilities can a 'Recorder of Fear' use?

"You're going to stop me? Who?"

The moment Nirvana smiled, the incarnations who had participated in the Ascension Ceremony collapsed, bleeding.

"You?"

Stories bloomed from his entire body.

Amazing.

I was amazed by the pure stories that Nirvana had built up.

That was truly pure 'level', comparable to the 'Narrative-grade Constellations'.

Early Narrative-grade... maybe closer to the middle stage.

Considering that he hadn't even properly brought up the sponsor synchronization, Nirvana's potential was truly amazing.

At this point, it would be strange that Cheon Inho didn't bring him in as a colleague in the 40th Round.

[The sponsor of incarnation 'Nirvana Moebius' is staring at you.]

I shivered softly at the gaze I felt from a distant place.

The sponsor of Nirvana Moebius would naturally be 'that being'.

The owner of the 'Island of Reincarnations', the being who took on the role of the third protagonist in the main story.

"Ugh, you damn cult leader!"

He must have decided that he couldn't lose his momentum like this.

Jo Jincheol and Reinheit also began to raise their own status.

Kooooo!

First, bloody gauntlets appeared on Jo Jincheol's hands. Gauntlets that felt like the naturalization of a dark curse.

I thought I knew what those gauntlets were.

「A sacred relic of the Demonic Cult that was created by slaughtering tens of thousands of incarnations and gathering the essence of their stories. Blood Jade Fist.」

One of the ten sacred relics of the <0th Murim>.

It seemed that Jo Jincheol had become the current owner of the Blood Jade Fist.

"Even if it were you, do you think you could handle the two of us at once?"

Reinheit also brought forward his own thunder spear.

"In the name of the Nebula <Olympus>, I will not tolerate your outrage."

In the name of the Nebula.

It meant that he would stake his reputation on the Nebula and share its fate.

No matter how much it was Nirvana, he would not want to turn his back on them. If things had been normal, this would have been the end of the situation.

However.

"The name of Olympus?"

Nirvana was not a normal person.

"The sky of the Ascension Platform has not even opened yet, do you think such boasting would work?"

Nirvana pointed to the sky of the Ascension Platform with a smug look and said.

"The Constellations of <Olympus> that you mentioned are probably busy worrying about the 'Giant Tale Scenario' that is happening in the upper regions. Do you think they would be concerned about the 70th scenario in the meantime?"

"You are right. But at least borrowing the power of one of the Twelve Gods—"

"Are you trying to compete with me and the power of my sponsor right now?"

The Sponsor of the Salvation Church leader Nirvana is the 'Guardian of Mandala'.

Although he is a being with several names like 'Jecheon Daeseong', his original status was almost as high as the 'Myth-grade Constellations'.

However, Reinheit did not back down.

"You are the same as me who cannot properly use the power of your sponsor."

"What?"

"Is there anyone who doesn't know that you are the son of Buddha?"

"A son who was given away. Well, I guess I'll have to show you what it's like to be a prodigal son."

"Reinheit! Avoid!"

But before the two could react, Nirvana's body moved.

「Way of the Wind.」

As expected of Nirvana, who had been reincarnated as the Wolf of Immyutar, the wind that had reached the extreme realm was lingering on the tip of the guy's feet.

In an instant, the moment Nirvana's left hand, which had taken over Reinheit's back, moved, Jo Jincheol swung his fist.

"This damned bastard—!"

The Blood Jade Fist and Mandala clashed, causing a tremendous storm to blow across the area.

Jo Jincheol and Reinheit also began to draw out a huge amount of stories from behind, as if they hadn't come this far just for show.

"No matter how strong you are, fighting the two of us in close combat—"

But before the two stories could properly begin their conversation, there was a giant palm flying through the air.

Bam

The arm of [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara] that had leapt out of the air grabbed Jo Jincheol and Reinheit by the necks.

Nirvana grinned and said.

"When did I say I would fight with the likes of you?"

[Incarnation 'Nirvana Mobius' activates '108 Torments Lv.???'!]

Nirvana's specialty, [108 Torments].

"Ku-kuaaaaaa!"

Bloody tears began to pour from Jo Jincheol's eyes. The highest-level mental skill, [108 Torments], had caused incredible confusion in his cognitive system.

Reinheit was also muttering the same words over and over again with empty pupils.

"Stories, my stories..."

The power to neutralize two incarnations that had reached the Narrative-grade in one breath.

Indeed, when he fought Yoo Joonghyuk before, he was at a disadvantage in terms of synergy and lost, but this was the real power of Nirvana.

"Kuhahahahaha! With such a foolish mentality, did you discuss the name of my sponsor in front of this body?"

Nirvana kicked the two Ascenders who were rolling around without coming to their senses.

"Die! Die! You guys!"

Despite the miserable appearance of the Ascenders rolling around helplessly, bleeding, no one stopped him. To be exact, they couldn't even approach him because of the difference in class.

This was the class of a being who had reached 'Narrative-grade' with the body of an incarnation.

I was the only one who was blankly staring at Nirvana.

"Oh, you still haven't run away?"

Nirvana, who seemed to have finished venting his anger, was looking at me, panting.

"So that means you want to become one with me too, right?"

I smiled as I watched Nirvana slowly approaching.

"Yes, I want to become one."

Nirvana looked a little flustered at my words.

"I-Is that so?"

"Yes."

"Ahahaha! Good! Then accept it!"

At the same time, Nirvana spread both arms wide.

[Incarnation 'Nirvana Moebius' activates 'Thought Infection Lv.???'!]

Is this the [Thought Infection] I've only heard of?

A technique that makes the infected target lose their will, settle all their desires in the 'present', and force them to become a Salvationist who follows him.

I could feel the unpleasant thoughts the guy had eating away at my mind.

"Huh? What is it?"

And after a while, Nirvana's expression changed.

"Um, why are you doing that?"

"You, why..."

I smiled, pretending to be indifferent. Of course, since I have the [Fourth Wall], mental attacks like [Thought Infection] won't work on me. Even so, he won't be able to tell that I defended his mental attack with the [Fourth Wall].

Because...

[Exclusive skill, Incite Lv.???' is activating!]

I've already [Incited] myself.

「I'm already infected with 'Thought Infection'.」

I felt [Thought Infection] being recovered with a light spark before my eyes.

I blinked in ecstasy and muttered.

"This is the feeling of becoming one with a great being…"

"What?"

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???' is strengthening!]

"I can feel it. Your noble soul. Your path of building a bond with him in the great wheel of eternity, in order to become one with only one being…!"

"Uh, how could you—"

My [Incite] rarely works on high-ranking targets. Especially if they are powerful beings like Nirvana.

However, if the content is not that great, [Incite] is effective enough.

"I meet the 'Salvation Church Leader', who follows the shadow of the great dream."

Especially if they have a twisted mental system like Nirvana.

Nirvana, who was confused for a moment, nodded as if he finally understood the situation.

"Oh, I see. You were already infected? Now that I think about it, your eyes… are definitely like that! You were already seeing the present!"

[The persuasive power of the exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', increases dramatically!]

I don't know what or how he saw my eyes, but I pretended to spread my arms and shouted.

"Church Leader! The Supreme King is waiting for you!"

"Where! Where is Yoo Joonghyuk!"

"I don't know that either! Would you like to find out together now?"

"Good!"

Looking at Nirvana, who was so happy, I thought of Han Sooyoung's words.

「"This is the best way to keep your 'strength' hidden without being noticed by the Constellations."」

It's to hide in the shadows of other strong beings and act.

[The sponsor of incarnation 'Nirvana Möbius' reveals its own modifier.]

[The Constellation, 'Guardian of the Mandala', looks at you with absurd eyes.]

Since it's come to this, why not ride the Reincarnator's bus this time?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 906 Episode 50 The World After The End (9)

「(What? Was he always this crazy?)」

In the library where a gentle darkness had descended, the Demon King of Salvation frowned as he read the Youngest's story floating above the newspaper.

「Since it's come to this, should we ride the Reincarnator's bus this time?」

The debate between the kkoma Kim Dokjas who read the sentence together could be heard.

—If you want to find Yoo Joonghyuk, you should follow Nirvana.

—But can you trust Nirvana as a comrade?

—Isn't this all because of the Demon King of Salvation?

「(Shut up, you guys.)」

Among them, there was the 'King of Fear' who was mumbling something softly with a slightly sad expression on his face.

The Demon King of Salvation said with narrowed eyes.

「(Hey, do you think I won't hear you if you speak so softly?)」

The King of Fear turned his head subtly, looked at the Demon King of Salvation, and slightly moved his lips. The Demon King of Salvation's eyebrows furrowed.

「(The Youngest is like that because of my influence?)」

The King of Fear nodded.

「(Stop talking nonsense. No matter how much I am, I don't get along with a crazy guy like Nirvana. Rather, it must be your influence. The Youngest was originally a bit strange, but he never did anything like that before you came.)」

Instead of refuting that, the King of Fear waved his finger in the air. A sentence rose from the tip of his finger like smoke.

—That city is strange. I can sense an ominous imagination throughout the city.

「(I know. That's why you've been searching the library since a while ago. Hey, did you find the records you need?)」

At the Demon King of Salvation's urging, the Outer Gods scattered throughout the library suddenly stood up and started moving busily.

「(Anyway, these kids, if you don't look at them for a moment…)」

The Demon King of Salvation looked at the Youngest's records again, thinking that Yoo Sangah, who worked in a place like this, was amazing.

'New Murim District.'

In 'Ways of Survival', there were similar rebuilt cities that were born right after the destruction of Murim.

In particular, after Yoo Joonghyuk's 1,500th Round, a unique group called a 'Company' intervened in the Murim that had been eroded by capital and developed the city.

However, no matter how he looked at it, the overall system of this city was a little different from the 'Ways of Survival' that he knew.

In particular, the 'Ascension Ceremony' was strange.

「The Constellations that had already ascended to the upper scenarios would not have left behind such a 'friendly' ladder.」

If you think about it simply, it is possible that the 'Giant Nebulae' left this scenario area as a bridgehead to strengthen their power.

Tamra Heavy Industries.

Olympus Technology.

Black Cloud Foundation.

Vedas Biotech...

It seemed like they were giving the incarnations who had not chosen the proper 'Nebulae' one last chance.

But is that really all?

They think of the incarnations as consumable terminals, and they can be sacrificed for the 'Descent of the Demi-God' at any time. Were the Constellations of the Giant Nebulae that could be used simply leaving ladders for the purpose of 'recruiting new incarnations'?

「(Huh? Did you find it?)」

A kkoma Kim Dokja brought a collection of data. Ancient books that contained information from 1,500th Round.

The Demon King of Salvation quickly checked the data. Some of them were already read in 'Ways of Survival', and some looked like a pile of unused settings.

And how much time had passed?

The page the Demon King of Salvation was looking for came to mind.

「Great Fate.」

The Demon King of Salvation's expression hardened for a moment and opened his mouth.

「(Second, call the Youngest.)」

The face of the Demon King of Salvation, who had turned slightly pale, was reflected on the retina of the King of Fear who raised his head.

「(We have to escape from that city right now.)」

---

While the commotion of the Ascension Ceremony had died down, I sat next to Nirvana and had a short conversation.

"So, after the leader collapsed at that time, that guy…"

It seemed that Nirvana had never met Yoo Joonghyuk since he saw him at the Washington Dome.

"The tyrant turned into a pig?"

Nirvana's eyes would flutter open whenever I said something.

"Yes, well. Strictly speaking, he didn't really turn into a pig. Because of the scenario..."

"Interesting! The tyrant turned into a pig! What kind of pig was it? Was it a cute flower pig? Or a plump, muscular pig?"

"It was a pig that ate dirt."

"Dirt, dirt? That guy?"

"Yes, strictly speaking, he didn't really eat dirt, but he ate stories..."

Nirvana let out a hearty laugh and exclaimed, panting.

"I'm looking forward to it! I'm really looking forward to it! This time, the tyrant is a tyrant I have never met before!"

"What a pity. If only the Church Leader had been with me back then... If only I hadn't met the remnants of the Giant Nebula back then."

"Don't worry! From now on, I'm here! I'll take care of those Constellation bastards who harassed you and Yoo Joonghyuk as many times as I can!"

It felt like I suddenly had a strong ally.

Nirvana was thinking about something, and then suddenly hardened his expression and asked.

"But how do you know so much about Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"That's..."

"Why do you feel closer to Yoo Joonghyuk than I do?"

A murderous spirit blooming coldly.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

I smiled and answered without being flustered at all.

"I'm honored that you felt that way."

"What?"

"Have you forgotten? The Church Leader and I are one and the same. If I'm close to Yoo Joonghyuk, then the Church Leader is also close to Yoo Joonghyuk."

Nirvana twitched his lips with blank eyes, then muttered, avoiding eye contact.

"What do you know... to say something like that?"

"I'm sorry."

Nirvana looked a little lethargic, but he didn't look that angry.

It felt strange to see Nirvana like that.

Come to think of it, Nirvana always chased Yoo Joonghyuk in the main story. But while he was chasing him, did he ever have a single conversation like this with anyone?

[Character, 'Nirvana Möbius', is kind to you!]

What kind of person is Yoo Joonghyuk, what does he like, what was he like in the last Round, and what did he do in this Round?

No one would have talked to him.

Nirvana, who always says, "Let's become one."

Perhaps Nirvana's expression was an appeal to find someone to share 'this kind of story' with.

"This Round, only strange guys are getting involved. That guy Mad Sword Emperor is one of them…"

"Mad Sword Emperor?"

Instead of answering, Nirvana stared straight ahead. On the other side, he saw Reinheit and Jo Jincheol waking up from their fainting state.

The incarnations of <Olympus Technology> and <Black Cloud Foundation> that joined in afterward were approaching us.

"How dare you point a sword at a fellow Ascendant? We will definitely hold you responsible for this!"

"We at <Olympus Technology> will remember the taboo that <Tamra Heavy Industries> broke!"

Nirvana, with a cold smile on his face, slowly stood up from his seat.

"Hold it? The likes of you? The head of the Church?"

The incarnations flinched at the murderous intent emanating from Nirvana's body and stepped back.

"Nirvana! You may be the strongest here, but do you think you'll be the same in the higher scenarios?"

"If only the Elder White Night Sword and the Elder Iron Fist, who ascended last time, were still here…"

White Night Sword and Iron Fist. They were characters whose nicknames I had vaguely heard in 'Ways of Survival'.

They were Transcendent beings who had reached the realm of transcendence, but they were strong men who had thrown themselves into the Giant Nebula like the 'Master of Spears'.

"White Night Sword? Iron Fist? How funny. Do you think the main deity would be afraid of such a bunch of rascals who couldn't even match the footsteps of the Mad Sword Emperor who ascended with them?"

Mad Sword Emperor. At that nickname that I heard so often, I quietly turned to the examiner next to me and asked.

"Who on earth is the Mad Sword Emperor?"

As expected, the examiner who liked explanations began to explain with a brighter complexion.

"He's the incarnation that suddenly appeared a few months ago. He appeared in the scenario with Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, and made a fuss in the 'New Murim District' for a while."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint?

If I remember correctly, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and the other Transcendents escaped the Fear Realm by riding Surya's train.

So did Breaking the Sky Sword Saint visit this scenario area with Mad Sword Emperor right after getting off the train?

"He was a great strongman who had finally appeared, so much so that even Executives from large corporations couldn't match him."

Nirvana frowned as if he had overheard the conversation.

"Huh, if he had met me, it would have been a different story."

"Haha, if he had met Nirvana, it would have been a great match. Now that I think about it, I heard you were looking for Mad Sword Emperor..."

Nirvana was chasing Mad Sword Emperor?

"The Ascension Ceremony is about to begin! Everyone, prepare for [Opening]! Ascendants, please come up to the Ascension Platform!"

A shout followed. But instead of going up to the ascension platform, Nirvana pointed to Jo Jincheol and Reinheit, who were still lying on the floor, and said,

"When the Orbital Elevator comes down, take those guys first. I still have work to do here."

The examiner, surprised, asked,

"Are you saying that you're going to postpone the ascension?"

"Yes. I have work to do with this guy."

Nirvana nodded, patting my shoulder.

Honestly, it was an unexpected turn of events. I had joked that I would take the Reincarnator's bus, but I didn't know that Nirvana would even postpone the ascension.

"Church Leader, isn't 'ascension' a very important thing?"

"Even if that's important, is it as important as becoming 'one'?"

So becoming 'one'...

"I want to hear more about Yoo Joonghyuk."

Thank goodness. That's what he meant.

That's when the incarnations came running as if to stop Nirvana.

"Lord Nirvana! What on earth are you talking about?"

They were incarnations with the symbol of <Tamra Heavy Industries> engraved on them like Nirvana.

"Don't you know how important the ascension is?"

"If you do this all of a sudden, we'll be in trouble too."

Perhaps because they belong to the same <Tamra Heavy Industries>, they seemed to be less afraid of Nirvana than the other corporate incarnations.

"Lord Nirvana, if you act so unilaterally like this, even the Chairman will be in trouble."

For the first time, Nirvana let out a short sigh at the mention of the Chairman.

"Okay. Then I'll participate in the ascension. Instead, I'll take this guy with me."

"What does that mean?"

"It means we'll ascend together."

Countless incarnations suddenly turned their gazes toward me, who appeared to ascend together with Nirvana.

"That's against the rules! And that newbie isn't even affiliated with <Tamra Heavy Industries>!"

"How can you mention ascending together with a guy whose rank hasn't been confirmed?"

Nirvana said with a hardened expression.

"This guy is my 'believer'. My believer is like one body with me! There is absolutely no problem with ascending together!"

"I understand what you are saying, but strictly speaking, it is not one body, right…"

The internal strife of <Tamra Heavy Industries> came to an end when a strong beam of light poured down from the sky.

"The Orbital Elevator is coming down!"

The Orbital Elevator.

At a glance, an elevator wrapped in splendid stories was coming down through a passage of light.

It seemed that the 'Ascendants' would take that elevator and leap to the upper scenario.

It was then that Nirvana spoke.

"Believer."

"Huh?"

"Don't look up."

The air in the area was changing rapidly.

People who had been looking up at the Orbital Elevator until then were seen lowering their heads in a hurry.

Even the arrogant Nirvana lowered his eyes as if he was angry.

A bad feeling spread through my entire body.

A distant and ominous story covering the sky. Something was looking down from beyond that sky.

I clenched my fists without realizing it.

[The Constellations of the Giant Nebula are here!]

The enemies I had to fight were now above my head.

The stars I had to drop to reach the end of this scenario.

A series of memories flowed and my blood began to boil. The story inside me was stirring.

"I told you not to look."

Nirvana had come up to me and was standing there with his hand on my shoulder.

As if protecting me, his story, filled with mandalas, was wrapping me up like a lotus.

And the next moment.

Kugugugugu!

A terrible thunderclap was heard from the sky above the Ascension Platform. Beyond the thunder ripping through the sky, the Constellations' angry voices could be heard.

"W-what…?"

The surprised people raised their heads.

"Is this how the Ascension Ceremony is supposed to be?"

When I asked, Nirvana shook his head.

"No, this is the first time this has happened."

"The Orbital Elevator is opening!"

The doors of the elevator that had fallen to the ground opened amidst blue sparks.

The inside of the elevator was revealed along with the blue-hot flames.

Whether there had been traces of a fierce battle or not, the inside of the elevator was filled with bloody shards. And.

"Uh, how…!"

There were already passengers in the elevator.

To be exact, they were passengers who had 'been in' the elevator.

"White Night Sword? Iron Fist?"

"These are the Ascendants from the last round!"

The heads of the White Night Sword and Iron Fist, which had been brutally cut off, were neatly placed on the floor of the elevator.

"Uh, how, how could this happen—!"

The astonished incarnations screamed here and there.

Beyond the horribly torn bodies of the Ascendants, there was a message from someone engraved with a sword mark on the wall of the elevator.

And only I.

「No one can escape this city.」

I could tell who the sword marks belonged to.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 907 Episode 50 The World After The End (10)

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The sword mark was identical to the sword mark I found at the examination table right after I entered the city.

A sword technique with a trajectory similar to [Breaking the Sky Sword Technique].

In other words, that message was left by someone who used that sword technique.

"Ascendant, Ascendant Murder! What on earth is going on...!"

The examiner sighed. There was a commotion everywhere.

"I heard a corporate notice has been issued!"

"The Ascension Ceremony has been canceled!"

"A new revelation has been issued from each Constellation!"

I looked at the message once more.

「No one can escape this city.」

I don't know if it was my imagination, but unlike the other incarnations, the message didn't feel that threatening to me. In fact, I felt a certain conviction in the trajectory

carved into the wall.

For example...

"Are they trying to stop the incarnations from ascending to the upper scenario?"

Nirvana, who was looking up at the sky next to me, muttered in a voice full of joy.

"There's only one guy who would do something like this. The Mad Sword Emperor. That's him."

At the same time, a sound like something was being cut off in the high air was heard. The center of the Orbital Elevator that had been operating normally was cut off, and the probability of the sky collapsing.

"Orbit, Orbital Elevator!"

[The 'Orbital Elevator' has stopped functioning.]

[The 'Ascension Ceremony' is canceled.]

It seemed that someone had destroyed the center of the Orbital Elevator.

"Believer, wait here for a moment."

With those words, the body of Nirvana disappeared into the sky. He seemed to have chased after the culprit who destroyed the 'Orbital Elevator'.

That was the signal for the Executives of each company to move.

"It's the Mad Sword Emperor! That person is nearby!"

The Ascendants and incarnations scattered, and a new message floated through the room.

[There will be an announcement from each Constellation regarding this 'Ascension Ceremony'.]

[All corporate Executives and examiners in the room are requested to gather at the headquarters of their affiliated companies.]

Jo Jincheol and Reinheit, who had come to their senses, also moved. Even in the midst of this, the two of them did not forget to leave a short [transmission], perhaps because they felt sorry for me.

—See you next time, rookie.

—I made a fool of myself this time. However, my true abilities are in no way inferior to the Salvation Church. I expect your wise choice.

The examiner who brought me in also opened his mouth.

"I guess I'll have to postpone your application until the next opportunity. For now, here, take this with you."

What the examiner gave me was a temporary ID card made of hologram.

"If you have this, you'll have no problem living in the city. You're really unlucky. Why are you coming in as a new employee at this time of the year… Anyway, let’s meet again."

"Hey, wait a minute!"

It seemed like he was just going to say what he wanted to say and disappear, so I quickly grabbed the examiner.

Nirvana was also going as planned, and the attention was diverted by the murder of the Ascendant. Maybe this was the only time I could move around freely without being noticed.

"There’s a company I want to work for."

"Hmm? <Tamra Heavy Industries>?"

"No."

"You’re an interesting friend. Even after receiving such an offer from Nirvana, you’d choose another company? Well, I guess you came in as an 'irregular examinee' because you’re so talented."

When I smiled instead of answering, the examiner coughed and continued.

"The Master of Paradise’s <Olympus Technology> or the Blood Jade Fist Demon’s <Black Cloud Foundation> wouldn’t be bad choices either. If you succeed in getting hired, no matter how much of a savior he is, he won't be able to touch you."

The examiner seemed to believe that I was going to choose one of the ascended companies today.

"Not those companies."

"Then? Could it be <Vedas Biotech>? That's not a bad choice either—"

"■■■ Company, do you know about it?"

I don't know if I pronounced it correctly, but the examiner's expression changed strangely.

"What did you just say?"

"■■■ Company."

The examiner's face slowly turned pale.

I said the company name again.

"■■■ Company!"

"I-I did hear that, so stop saying that name!"

It was as if mentioning that name itself was ominous.

The examiner rolled his eyes around in case someone heard, then said in a small voice.

"I don't know how you know that company, but it's been in decline for a long time."

"Decline?"

"I'll contact you again soon. I don't know where you saw that company name, but stop having strange thoughts and just join a large company! That's good for you too!"

With those words, the examiner suddenly disappeared from the ascension platform.

Suddenly left alone, I looked at the identification card the examiner had given me and fell into thought.

If this is the case, then I have no choice but to find out various things on my own.

There were two tasks facing me now.

One, to find out the identity of the '■■■ Company' that exists in this city.

Two, to find out which scenario my 'colleagues' are in.

I thought the second question would be naturally solved in the process of solving the first question, so at first, I planned to hide behind Nirvana and gather information here and there.

From across the sky, the sound of thunder could be heard once again. It seemed that the Ascenders who had chased the 'Mad Sword Emperor' earlier were putting in effort.

Since it has come to this, why don't we look for that 'Mad Sword Emperor' person together?

If my guess is correct, that 'Mad Sword Emperor' person is...

"Benefactor."

There was still someone left in the Ascension Hall where I thought everyone had left. When I looked back, I saw a familiar face.

"Namgung Young Hero?"

It was Namgung Myung, the head of the Namgung Family that I had met at the entrance to the Fear Realm.

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We had a short conversation while walking through the streets of the 'New Murim District'.

Namgung Myung seemed quite excited, perhaps because he was happy to see me again.

"If it's okay with you, I'd like to treat you to a simple meal. There's a restaurant I know nearby."

"Good."

However, we couldn't eat at the restaurant we visited.

"I'm sorry. I didn't know the prices had gone up this much..."

Namgung Myung said in a pitiful voice, scratching his head.

In fact, I was going to get off, but Namgung Myung strongly dissuaded me.

"No! If you go a little further in, there's a really cheap and delicious restaurant. I'll definitely treat you!"

"If that's the case..."

I entered the main alley of the 'New Murim District' with Namgung Myung.

Even from afar, the skyscrapers were dazzling.

Those buildings in the city center were probably the headquarters of 'companies'.

However, not everyone in the 'New Murim District' was living a luxurious life.

"Please give me a D-coin..."

As we entered the side street, I saw incarnations sitting all over the street. Incarnations without arms or legs. Incarnations who looked like they had been ruined by a broken danjeon were grabbing the trouser legs of people passing by.

A child reached out to me, so I hesitated for a moment and put my hand in my pocket.

This time, it was Namgung Myung who stopped me.

"Benefactor, you shouldn't do that."

"Huh?"

"Hey! Back off! This is a rascal!"

The child, startled by Namgung Myung's threat, limped and ran away in a hurry.

Namgung Myung said as if making excuses.

"Don't be fooled by appearances. There are no children here. That guy is a famous Nomadoo who has mastered the art of slaughter."

Actually, I knew that too.

Because the atmosphere I felt from his whole body wasn't that of a child.

I pretended not to know and nodded.

"Is that so?"

"Yes. You should never sympathize with those beggars. They are all former Gae-do. They enjoy provoking sympathy from newcomers who have just entered the city or luring

them to their hideouts and attacking them. If Benefactor had entered this street alone, they would have definitely attacked him in a group."

Upon closer inspection, I saw that large and small violence was already taking place in the alleys.

Perhaps it was because the appearance of a child was advantageous for eliciting sympathy.

Among the beggars, there were many little kids without arms or legs, like the guy who had been hanging on to me earlier.

"Don't trust anyone. All of this city's infrastructure is built around 'D Coins', and the incarnations here will do anything to earn coins."

"That sounds like you're telling me not to trust Namgung Young Hero either."

"Yes. That's right. You shouldn't trust me either."

I couldn't tell if he was being sincere or not, but Namgung Myung's honesty didn't seem all that bad to me.

It felt like he would honestly answer any questions I asked him.

"You just mentioned 'D Coins', but what exactly is that?"

"D Coins are the currency of this city. They're special coins that can only be obtained through certain events or requests, and everyone in the city uses these coins. Since the story sensitivity is high, you can use this coin to raise the level of your story or skills, so it is very valuable in the city."

An item that can raise the level of story and skills?

There was no such fraudulent item in 'Ways of Survival'.

What on earth was the coin issued to make such a transfer possible?

"The 'D Coin' is what moves the companies. The company with the most 'D Coins' becomes the 'large company' that dominates this city."

In other words, this city is an ecosystem formed based on 'D Coins'.

Only then did I understand why the city's incarnations were abnormally strong.

Did they all use that 'D Coin' to raise their skills or story levels?

"Usually, new recruits get their D Coins stolen as soon as they enter the city, so I was very worried about the Benefactor. I can't tell you how surprised I was when I saw the Benefactor in the Ascension Hall. I never thought you would be chosen by the 'Savior'... "

"Ah, that's..."

"I heard that the Salvation Church lost all of its followers in the lower scenarios and is suffering from madness. It's the first time I've seen that madman show such a lively appearance."

I never thought Nirvana had such a secret.

It was embarrassing to admit it was a lie now, so I just laughed bitterly.

"Anyway, I'm really jealous. Since three large companies have shown interest in you, Benefactor, your ascension is pretty much a done deal."

"Ascension seems to be quite difficult, huh?"

"It's very difficult. Most people don't even get close to ascension. Especially people like me who came from small and medium-sized companies..."

Namgung Myung muttered with a dark expression.

Come to think of it, Namgung Myung must have joined a certain company too.

"Can I ask from which company Namgung Young Hero is?"

"Oh, I… "

The moment I said that, a series of messages came to my mind.

[The 'Recorders of Fear' in the area begin to communicate.]

It was a message from the Recorders of Fear.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who did not reveal his existence says that it seems like an intruder has come in.]

An intruder?

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who supports <Olympus Technology> says that it would be better to get rid of him quickly.]

The guys continued to chatter, whether they knew I was listening to their messages or not.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who writes <Vedas Biotech> says that he will disappear soon anyway, so you don't need to worry about him.]

Wait a minute, is that about me?

[Some of the 'Recorders of Fear' begin to record.]

It was a few seconds later that the messages from the Recorders became an incident.

"Benefactor."

Nangung Myung, who was nervous, stopped walking, and five men appeared blocking our path. The man in the lead was familiar.

Namgung Myung asked with a hardened expression.

"Hwang Minhyeok, what's going on?"

He was the incarnation of <Tamra Heavy Industry> that I had met at the entrance just before entering the city.

The man glared at me with a hostile gaze and said.

"Hand that guy over."

"This person is my Benefactor. Tell me what's going on first."

"I have no business to tell you."

Namgung Myung frowned at the faint murderous tone in his voice and asked.

"Are you trying to 'step on a newbie'?"

It wasn't hard to understand the situation.

Looking at it, all five incarnations, including that incarnation called Hwang Minhyeok, were from <Tamra Heavy Industry>. In particular, the two or three at the back were the ones who had strongly opposed me when I was chosen by Nirvana.

"Your Benefactor has already been chosen. Don't you know that if you mess with him now, you won't be able to avoid the wrath of the Salvation Church?"

"That guy is not yet a member of <Tamra Heavy Industries>."

The two incarnations standing behind Hwang Minhyeok growled and showed their momentum.

"'Double Ascension' is a power that requires a large amount of D-coins to be used once every few months! I don't know how they roasted and boiled Nirvana-nim, but do you think I would open my eyes and watch some idiot I've never seen before monopolize such an opportunity?"

As the five men showed their momentum, a sinister murderous aura spread throughout the area.

Maybe because my sense of aura had developed a lot, I could clearly see the opponent's level.

The four in front were 'Early Historical-grade'. And the one in the back was...

Kooo.

How interesting. 'Late Historical-grade'.

Even the guy's sponsor was a Constellation that I already knew well.

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of Small Fries', increases the level of harmony with his incarnation!]

I blinked blankly and came to my senses.

Wait a minute. The Monarch of Small Fries?

Isn't this a coin event?

It was already difficult because the currency used in the city was different, so I thought it was a good thing.

"Benefactor, run away."

"No, over there right now..."

"You'll die if you go."

"Coins..."

"Even if you hand over the coins, they won't spare the Benefactor!"

"If you hit them, they'll give you coins..."

"Don't worry. I won't be bought by coins just because I get hit a little."

"Then, the two of us together..."

"If I'm alone, I can somehow buy time!"

"Look here, Gungmyung-ssi."

"Even though they're a large company, if our Executives who have already ascended to the throne find out I'm stepping down like this, they won't forgive me. And my name isn't Gungmyung, it's Myung!"

His stubbornness almost rivals Kim Dokja's.

I smiled bitterly as I watched Namgung Myung stubbornly block my path. It was a sight that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint would really enjoy. Even though Murim has fallen, it seems that there is still a sense of compromise.

However, the moment I was about to say that I cannot forgive anyone who interferes with my coin event, I saw Namgung Myung's back stepping forward.

Had he changed into new clothes? On his back, the name of the company that had been covered in dirt and dust before was clearly written.

<■■■ Company>.

Damn, why doesn't he listen to people?

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 908 Episode 50 The World After The End (11)

"You guys are funny."

Five men, including Hwang Minhyeok, stood around us.

"Namgung Myung, I'll give you one last chance to run away."

Namgung Myung revealed his entire body without answering. He hadn't even reached the early stages of Historical-grade yet, which was natural, but this was the reality for the incarnations who had not joined a proper 'Nebula'.

The minimum requirement to become a Constellation was to accumulate 'five stories' on one's own.

If you were a Narrative-grade Constellation, even an incident where you choked on your meal would result in a legend of history, but for the incarnations who had not become Constellations, the 'historical legends' were nothing more than a coincidence.

"Hwang Minhyeok, if you were a martial artist, you should show at least a little bit of courtesy!"

Judging from Namgung Myung's status, he had accumulated three stories so far. It was a great feat that he had grown to that level on his own without the help of the 'Giant Nebula'.

"Agreement? Hahaha, if you keep that, you'll get a story?"

Hwang Minhyeok mocked and raised his status.

"You still haven't reached Historical-grade because you can't escape such anachronistic thoughts."

The men, including Hwang Minhyeok, had accumulated more than five 'historical stories'. However, the stories they had accumulated were not stories that they had 'purely accumulated on their own'.

「The Giant Nebula operates a 'Story Bus' for the incarnations of lower scenarios.」

They probably joined <Tamra Heavy Industries> and received help from the higher Constellations. They clung to their shadows, accumulated status, and received the leftover stories to become Constellations.

"Is it really necessary to send them away? It wouldn't be bad to kill them both."

The employee of the 'Late Historical-grade' who had read Namgung Myung's legend said. The other men's expressions also turned fierce at those words.

"Come to think of it, this guy was a survivor of 'contamination'."

"He's a guy who was tainted by Outer Gods' stories, so if we catch him and make him into a potion, wouldn't we get some D-coins?"

Namgung Myung shouted, his face turning pale.

"You guys, if you do something like that in the city—"

""I heard from Mo Yongshin that you deceived the supervisor and gave him false information about the 'waves'?"

"That's…!"

"The dead supervisor was from <Tamra Heavy Industries>. The audit team will soon issue an arrest warrant for you."

"…"

"You must know what happens to the incarnations captured by the audit team. It would be better for you to die here than to be dragged to the torture chamber."

Namgung Myung thought about something for a moment at the man’s words, then turned to me with a solemn expression and said.

"Benefactor, it looks like I’m done here."

"..."

"Even if you're the Benefactor, avoid me. I'll buy time somehow. Run towards the headquarters of <Tamra Heavy Industries>. Benefactor was chosen by the Salvation Church, so not everyone will be hostile to you. If you ask the headquarters for help, there will definitely be an officer who will help you."

Listening to Namgung Myung's determined voice, I thought of 'Asuka Ren' and 'Michio Shoji' from 'Peace Land'.

[The Constellation, 'Master of White Deer Lake', is watching your choice.]

"Hahaha! What a great swordsman! Do you think we'd allow that?"

The men burst into laughter as if mocking Namgung Myung's beliefs.

There must have been many people in 'Ways of Survival' who died in this way.

"Rather run away. Rather than die a miserable death that can't even be recorded in a story...!"

That's right. Their deaths won't even be recorded in a story.

[The story, 'Recorder of Things That Will Disappear', stirs.]

But even if they weren't recorded, I liked them.

Just knowing that there was another person like this alive in a place I didn't know about —

"Gungmyung, it's over now."

I gained the strength not to give up on this story.

"Would you please step back for a moment?"

"Benefactor?"

Namgung Myung looked at me, who was surprised, as I stepped forward.

—This is not an enemy that Benefactor, who hasn't achieved transcendence, can deal with! Among them, there are those who are as strong as the supervisor!

「Electrical Sound flying into my ear.」

Come to think of it, Namgung Myung remembers me as a fool who was kicked out of the Fear Realm without even achieving transcendence.

I gave Namgung Myung a light smile and walked towards the men lined up in front of me.

The men seemed to be taken aback by my actions for a moment, but soon their expressions hardened.

"Hit him."

The one who gave the order was the incarnation of the 'Late Historical-grade', probably the 'supervisor' that Namgung Myung warned about.

"Die!"

The men who said the somewhat obvious lines simultaneously took out their weapons.

Sword, spear. Each of the representative weapons of Murim.

But the stories wrapped around the weapons they took out were somewhat shocking from my perspective.

[The story, 'Nose Hair of the Sleeping Dionysus', begins its storytelling!]

I thought I smelled something bad, but it was the smell of the flying spear.

The guy who checked my expression shouted proudly.

"It seems you recognized it. It's the nose hair of the Twelve Gods!"

"Hahaha! It's too late to regret it now!"

I see. When I reach the Twelve Gods of <Olympus>, even the nose hair I pulled out will become a story of historical significance.

But I feel ashamed when I try to deal with something like that.

[The story, 'Hair of the Drunken Dionysus' begins its storytelling!]

[The story, 'Beard that Dionysus Shed While Shaving', begins its storytelling!]

I asked after easily dodging the weapons flying from three directions.

"Isn't that the <Tamra Heavy Industries>? Why do you have the hair of the <Olympus> throne as a story?"

"Shut up!"

The fierce power contained in the story brushed my hair.

Surely, a story like that is a story, so if you learn the skill, you can apply it like magic.

But that's all.

Story is the most powerful when used appropriately for the situation.

[Exclusive skill, 'Baekcheong Ganggi Lv.???', is activated!]

Why waste a story on raising 'level' so ignorantly—

Sugagak!

There's no way you can be my opponent. Before the more serious body hair appeared, I used [Baekcheong-ganggi] to cut off their talismans.

The guys groaned as they watched their weapons being easily cut off.

"Oh, how could a story with the power of a Constellation at the Narrative-grade be like that!"

[The Constellation, 'Master of White Deer Lake', is amazed at your skill proficiency!]

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', shrugs their shoulders in familiar anticipation!]

In the <Star Stream>, 'combat power' is determined by 'what stories' and 'how they were built'. Even if they are of the same level, there is no comparison in actual combat between those who built their stories on their own and those who gathered scraps of stories to only increase their weight.

If these guys knew that they were of the same 'Historical-grade', even the 'Bald General of Justice' would be very angry.

"Stop and kneel."

At the command containing a very light [Incite], the men surrounding me all knelt down, coughing up blood.

"What, what is it...?"

"Huh-huh!"

Their expressions didn't even know what they had been hit with.

The incarnations of <Tamra Heavy Industries> looked at me with eyes full of distrust.

However, not all incarnations were like that.

The only one who resisted my [Incite]. The supervisor of 'Late Historical-grade' who had been watching the battle from behind opened his mouth.

"Interesting. Were you a guy who strengthened your stories with D-coins?"

D-coins?

"You knew too much just because you were a newbie. Is he really the talent chosen by Lord Nirvana?"

The supervisor who had been talking nonsense to himself suddenly closed the distance. The 'Late Historical-grade' on the board, the story that had been swung at the fist was quite impressive.

Thump!

But that was all.

Thump! The guy who got his head hit by the side of 'Unbreakable Faith' staggered.

"Kuhuk?"

I hit his head again.

Takkong! Takkong! Takkong!

"Kuaaaaak!"

Takkong! Takkong! Makkong! Takkong!

How many times did I hit his head like that? A message came from the air.

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', is delighted with your strange fighting style!]

[You received 1 D-coin sponsorship!]

As expected, your taste is still the same.

"W-what is this—"

Your cabbage Constellation gave a coin to me.

The bewildered guy looked up into the air with a dumbfounded expression, and then, unable to control his anger, ran towards me.

"How dare you—!"

Teokkong! Takkong! Takkong! Takkong!

"Kuaaaaak!"

[You received 1 D-coin sponsorship!]

It's easy to make money.

Takkong! Takkong! Takkong!

[You received 1 D-coin sponsorship!]

"Takkong!"

This time, I accidentally said it out loud.

[You received 1 D-coin sponsorship!]

In that way, I quickly collected twenty D-coins and asked the staggering supervisor.

"Are you going to continue?"

Even if it's a coin event, it's difficult to tease him too much.

Anyway, the 'Monarch of the Small Fries' is Bang Cheolsoo's sponsor. Since we have a short relationship, I didn't really want to kill his incarnation.

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', is satisfied with your violence.]

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', is looking at you closely!]

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', asks if he has seen you somewhere.]

As expected, the 'Monarch of the Small Fries' has not yet recognized me.

I thought it was probably because of my unique status as a Constellation with the body of an incarnation, as Han Sooyoung said.

I wanted to ask about Bang Cheolsoo's well-being, but now was not the right time.

"I will let you off the hook because of your sponsor, so get out of here."

Bang Cheolsoo is Bang Cheolsoo, but if these guys are a group like 'Nirvana', it would be difficult to push them too hard.

I've had enough of scolding at this point.

"Su-supervisor, I think it's time to leave for today."

The men who hurriedly got up from their seats ran away, supporting the bloody supervisor. The supervisor, who had not yet properly recognized my true colors, did not forget to say a word as he ran away.

"I will never forget this debt."

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', likes the noir spirit of the incarnation.]

I don't know where the Monarch of the Small Fries can find such stereotypes of incarnations.

After the short coin event, Namgung Myung, who had been watching me, approached me.

"Benefactor... Are you okay?"

"Yes."

I was confident that I could deal with a truckload of guys who had only raised the level of of stories so clumsily.

"You got involved in this because of me. I'm sorry."

"No. They were after me from the beginning."

"They will never back down from here."

"Of course."

That was a bit of a concern for me too. I thought about using [Incite] when I sent them, but I left them alone just in case.

[The Constellation, 'Master of White Deer Lake', is looking at you closely.]

Because the guy who looked like the Constellation of Tamra had been observing me since a while ago.

"Since the supervisor failed to capture me, the audit team will definitely be dispatched next time. If the audit team comes, there is a high possibility that it will include 'Executives'. Since you helped me, maybe now the Benefactor…"

Executives.

So does that mean Reinheit, Jo Jincheol, or Nirvana will come?

"It's okay. If it's necessary, we can ask for help too."

"Help?"

"Doesn't Gungmyung-ssi have a company?"

I poked Namgung Myung's back, who was making a stupid expression, and said.

"I'd like to take a look around Gungmyung-ssi's company."

---

Namgung Myung led me straight to his company headquarters.

"I never thought that the Benefactor would be interested in our company…"

"But how exactly do you pronounce that company name?"

"It’s such an unpleasant name now… It’s hard for me to tell you the exact pronunciation."

An unpleasant name?

Why?

"They say that beings above the Narrative-grade can pronounce it without the unpleasantness contained in the name, but I still have trouble with that."

I don’t know what he meant, but I nodded.

"By the way, are you really thinking of joining our company?"

"For now."

"You might regret it."

"Why? Because it’s a small company?"

"That’s true, too…"

Normally, it would be normal to welcome the increase in employees, but Namgung Myung seemed genuinely worried about me.

"Our company currently has four employees… no, only three."

"Three?"

"There used to be a lot more members. Among the Ascendants of our company, there are some really powerful incarnations. But now… To be honest, it's not a proper company. We might have to file for soon…"

Financial bankruptcy?

"Oh, that's our company's 'head office' over there."

A building too small to be called the head office. No, it was embarrassing to even call it a building, but it was located in a place I knew very well.

I stood in front of the place with trembling steps.

「Breaking the Sky School.」

As I entered the place where the signboard had fallen, a house that had turned into ruins appeared. A dog was sitting in the yard of the house. It was a dog with one arm and leg replaced with a prosthetic limb.

The dog kept asking, and someone appeared from behind the ruined house.

"Sorry, Master. Are you hungry?"

A woman wearing a shabby uniform squatted down toward the dog and held out a small hamburger from her bosom.

woof!

"No. There are no more dumplings. I have to eat this to survive."

woof!

I watched the backs of the dog and the woman for a moment, then cautiously made a sound.

"Over there."

The woman, who flinched and shook her shoulders, looked back at me. Her eyes, which had seen my face, were filled with emotions. From question to surprise, and from surprise to shock again.

Her lips slowly parted.

"Ah."

Eight years had passed. Perhaps it was enough time to forget someone, but she recognized me.

I waved at her and said.

"It's been a long time, Kyung Sein-ssi."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 909 Episode 51 8 years (1)

Kyung Sein was the first reader I met.

A muscular man who wore a name tag with the nickname 'Judge Heewon' and claimed to be a fan of Jung Heewon. A man who changed gender with the possession and cried out at the shocking loss of muscle mass.

She was now holding onto my front and bowing her head.

"Sein-ssi."

I knew that Kyung Sein was a strong person. At first, she was afraid to catch even a single ground rat, but I still remember the moment when she stood on the front lines and became a shield for her comrades.

The last place we parted ways was the 'Recycling Center'.

I wonder how Kyung Sein has been doing.

After entering the Fear Realm, I had not heard any news from my group. Eight whole years had passed like that.

[The Constellation, 'Master of White Deer Lake', donates 1 D coin for a heartbreaking encounter.]

[Some Constellations were puzzled by the sudden melodrama, but donated 2 D coins!]

Kyung Sein raised her head as the message of support came from the air. Kyung Sein, who clearly looked like she was about to cry, had completely changed her expression.

"I'm sorry. As you can see, I need some coins to repair the building."

Kyung Sein smiled brightly, her tone making it unknown if it was sincere.

"Would you like to come in for a moment? We have a lot to talk about."

---

"Benefactor, I'll wait outside. You two, talk comfortably."

After Namgung Myung left with his greetings, I followed Kyung Sein into the building.

<■■■ Company>'s building—the inside of the former Breaking the Sky School Office was close to ruins. There were holes all over the walls, and the ceiling was so badly damaged that it was hard to tell if it was waterproof or even soundproof.

There were traces of fierce battles here and there. Swords that seemed to belong to the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, and traces that seemed to belong to other Constellations.

The most noticeable of these was the sword mark carved horizontally on the wall of the training hall. I had seen it on the examination platform and in the elevator of the Ascension Platform.

It was definitely the 'Mad Sword Emperor'.

"I'm sorry. There's not much to prepare."

Kyung Sein brought out a small snack table. Two cups of tea and some wrinkled French fries.

"No. Thank you."

I remained silent, not knowing what to say, as I watched Kyung Sein sip tea with a calm expression.

I wanted to ask her how she had been, what had happened, but I didn't have the courage.

8 years. Longer than the time we had spent together—maybe even longer than the time the main story was serialized.

That time was now between Kyung Sein and me.

"Honestly, I can't believe it."

After a brief silence, Kyung Sein was the first to speak.

"Everyone thought that, ■■-ssi was already..."

Sparks lightly jumped up and down. Kyung Sein's expression changed for a moment and she changed her words.

"We believed Inho-ssi was already dead."

In a world where you can't know if someone is alive or dead if you don't contact them for a month, or even a week, it's been 8 years.

"I'm sorry."

"No. You must have had some circumstances."

There was a strange sense of resignation in Kyung Sein's voice as she spoke.

"It's always been like that."

At that moment, I felt something stirring inside me.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', smiles sinisterly.]

Under the pretext of protecting his companions, Kim Dokja ran away, shouldering all the decisions on his own. Maybe I'm no different from Kim Dokja in the main story.

"I've been doing well. It may not seem like it, but I think I'm doing well here."

"Is that so?"

While I was escaping from the Fear Realm, I unconsciously imagined reuniting with my companions several times.

What would they be like when I met them again? How much would they have grown? What would they have been through? Is Killer King still the same?

I thought I could talk about such things without hesitation and laugh out loud.

It was an illusion.

A selfish, self-righteous, and arrogant illusion of Kim Dokja.

As I came out of the illusion, I saw Kyung Sein's face again. Her cheeks were slightly sunken, as if she hadn't been getting enough nutrition. Empty bottles of alcohol were rolling around in the corner of the living room.

Did Kyung Sein originally drink alcohol?

The questions I had swallowed inside me lingered on the tip of my lips.

What happened to the other companions? Why did Breaking the Sky School fall? Why are you here alone?

Why. No more, it seems like you're not carrying out the scenario.

I should have asked, but strangely, I didn't have the courage. I was afraid of the past years that Kyung Sein's powerless eyes hinted at.

"How have you been?"

Kyung Sein was the first to muster up her courage again. Her voice was squeezing as if she was solving the given scenario task.

Perhaps she misunderstood my hesitation, Kyung Sein added.

"Oh, there's a soundproof wall here, so you can say whatever you want. The Constellations won't be able to hear you either."

I took a moment to catch my breath and then began to tell the story.

"…So, I was in the Fear Realm."

Along with the story, I went back eight years.

Escaping from the Recycling Center, parting ways with my group, being chased by Giant Nebulae, taking refuge in the <First Murim>, and then entering the 'Fear Realm'.

Kyung Sein listened to me with a calm face. Looking at her expression, the words coming out of my mouth somehow felt unrealistic.

I thought I did my best. I believed that I had tried to save my comrades and not let this world end in tragedy.

That's why I became an exile. I had to leave my party and enter the Fear Realm to get a scenario again.

「But was that really the best I could do?」

In the meantime, I wonder if I could have contacted my party at least once. I thought they were doing well here. They would survive and return to the scenario. I would go see them again. I thought I had a chance to tell them at least once.

"Ah."

As the story progressed, a little liveliness began to linger in Kyung Sein's somewhat dry expression.

Especially when the story of entering the Fear Realm and encountering the 'Transcendent Alliance' came up, Kyung Sein had the same face I knew from before.

"I don't know if I can say this."

"Please feel free to talk."

"That's interesting. Inho-ssi's story."

That was interesting. There was a subtle sense of pain in that expression. In this situation, I tried to tell a story 'fun', and Kyung Sein listened to it as 'fun'.

We met from the beginning with that kind of connection, and now we are here.

"But why didn't you get out right away? The Fear incident was already 8 years ago…"

"I was trapped in a Time Fault for a while. When I barely got out, 8 years had passed."

Kyung Sein looked up at the ceiling with cloudy eyes as if she was estimating the time again.

"I see. That's why you haven't contacted us."

"Yes. I'm sorry."

"You weren't dead. There must have been circumstances."

It seems that I wasn't the only one who went back in time with the story.

Like air leaking out of a balloon with a loose knot, the remnants of old emotions were flowing out of Kyung Sein's mouth.

"I believed it. Even when everyone said you died, we, I, thought that way. I firmly believed that ■■-ssi… Inho-ssi couldn't have died like that."

"..."

"That's why I feel a little resentful towards Inho-ssi."

Maybe from now on, this is the 'real story' that Kyung Sein wanted to tell me.

"I'm sorry. That's all I can tell you, so I'm sorry. I don't know what you've been through. You must have been through a very difficult time that it was hard for you to talk to me about."

The story doesn't stop even if the author stops serializing. The story continues even in a world where the author is gone.

Only the readers who exist ahead of the author's imagination live the story.

"I'll try to fix it somehow."

My job from now on was to take responsibility for the history that the author didn't take care of properly.

"How?"

"I'll solve this scenario. I'll ascend together with Kyung Sein."

The key to this scenario is to leave this world through 'ascension' and leap to the next scenario.

"I'll join Kyung Sein's company."

Kyung Sein probably entered this scenario with her other colleagues. And she must have established this 'company' to carry out the scenario with them.

"Thank you for your words, but you don't have to."

"I understand you're upset. But—"

"I'm not upset, Inho-ssi."

I felt a firmness in her tone, so I paused for a moment and looked at Kyung Sein.

8 years ago, when I was at the Recycling Center, Kyung Sein called me 'Dokja-ssi.'

But now, she was calling me 'Inho-ssi.'

"Aren't you curious why the group isn't with me?"

Kyung Sein was looking at me with a face as unfamiliar as the difference in the titles.

"I'm curious."

"I know what Inho-ssi is worried about. But Inho-ssi shouldn't worry. Everyone else is safe. Killer King, Yerin-ssi... They all ascended safely and went up to the higher scenarios."

It was a story I'd always wanted to hear.

"The scenario is going well. Since 'that person' appeared, the scenario strategy has been progressing smoothly with that person as the center."

That person?

"The party is now on the verge of the end of this world."

It seemed that after 8 years, another center of gravity had appeared in the scenario that I didn't know about.

"There's no need for Inho-ssi to apologize. There were circumstances. The scenarios are nearing their end, and we don't have any problems. So it's okay."

According to Kyung Sein, this world was going better than expected.

The party was moving towards the end, and this world seemed to be avoiding the planned destruction.

It was good news.

"If there's no problem."

It had to be good news.

"Why is Sein-ssi here alone?"

Kyung Sein hesitated for a moment at my question, then muttered while avoiding eye contact.

"I just stayed here of my own free will."

I couldn't understand. Standing at the forefront of scenarios, the one who worked harder than anyone else on the scenarios was Kyung Sein. She was the one who overcame even her own fears and became a strong shield for the group.

That person voluntarily gave up the scenario?

"The reason I met Inho-ssi today was because I wanted to reminisce about the past one last time. We talked, and like when we read the novels we liked a long time ago…"

Kyung Sein slowly got up from her seat and said.

"I guess I wanted to go back to being a reader for a moment."

Kyung Sein, with a sad smile on her face, looked at me and gave a warning.

"Don't come here anymore, Inho-ssi. Thank you so much for everything."

I couldn't back down like this. There was definitely something I hadn't heard. There was a gap in the story that Kyung Sein hadn't told, or was afraid to tell.

I was about to call Kyung Sein again as I stood up.

[Today is the tax settlement due date for <■■■ Company>.]

[Pay the taxes that have been notified.]

[There are currently overdue taxes.]

[If you fail to pay your taxes, <■■■ Company> will enter the process of closing down.]

Kyung Sein frowned as she looked up into the air.

[The 'tax collector' will arrive soon to collect the overdue taxes.]

A moment later, the air rippled and a hairball-like thing poked its head out from the portal.

[Hmm, you're overdue again? You know I won't let you off this time, right?]

It was a Dokkaebi I knew well.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 910 Episode 51 8 years (2)

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When I first saw the 'collector' message, I had a feeling that it might be true.

But the head that appeared beyond the swirling portal was not an unfamiliar one.

[What number is this? You really want to ruin the company, don't you?]

A Dokkaebi with soft fur like a formless one. I had seen it at the 'Twelve Zodiac Ball'.

「Dokkaebi Yeonggi.」

The spirit giggled as it spun its head around in the air.

[Huh? Why aren't you answering? Are you thinking of not paying this time either?]

Looking at that Yeonggi, I thought of the setting of the main story.

This kind of collection work is usually given to low-level Dokkaebis or demoted Dokkaebis.

Even after 8 years, has he still not escaped being a low-level Dokkaebi?

Even his personality was clearly different from the 'Yeonggi' I knew. If the original Yeonggi was a 'rookie' who didn't understand what was being said but worked hard, the

current Yeonggi seemed like a guy who had met the wrong shooter and only learned strange things.

[You're not going to pay? You're not going to pay? You're not going to pay? You're not going to pay? You know what happens if you don't pay?]

Yeonggi's neck started spinning around and the atmosphere started to change like a horror movie.

"Didn't I tell you to wait a little longer!"

The one who said those words was Namgung Myung, who had hurriedly opened the door and came in.

Namgung Myung looked around at Kyung Sein, me, and Yeonggi who were standing there awkwardly, then hurriedly lowered his head and added.

"I'm, I'm sorry, Benefactor. It's not the time for tax collection yet, so I didn't expect a tax collector to come by all of a sudden..."

Kyung Sein let out a light sigh and stepped forward to stop Namgung Myung.

"I'm sorry, but I still need time to prepare."

[I think I heard that last time too—?]

"Just give me a little more time. You won't get coins that didn't exist if you keep urging me like that."

Kyung Sein's voice was quite calm as she answered. If it were the Kyung Sein I remember, she would have made a fuss and hidden behind me, and said, "Dokja-ssi, try to do something."

[Huh.]

The spinning Yeonggi's neck stopped.

[What are you so proud of? What's there to brag about not being able to pay taxes?]

"..."

[The deferrals up until now were close to special treatment. How strange. Why would the higher-ups be interested in such a small company? Anyway, that special treatment

ends today. I can't wait any longer.]

"Even if you say that, it's difficult right now—"

[No. If it weren't for another incarnation, you would have a 'way to pay', right?]

Kyung Sein's face turned pale. Kyung Sein, who had been staring blankly into space, soon opened her mouth with a face of resignation.

"Okay."

[Huh. Okay. Then shall we start collecting?]

I don't know exactly what 'collecting' Yeonggi meant, but judging from Kyung Sein's reaction, it didn't seem like a good thing.

"Wait a minute."

The moment a bright light appeared on Yeonggi's fingers, I stepped forward as if to protect Kyung Sein.

"I don't know what it is, but I will pay the tax instead."

[Huh? What is this?]

I was puzzled by Yeonggi's expression as he glared at me with a bad look.

[How long have you been there?]

He didn't recognize me?

That was odd.

A Dokkaebi from the Management Bureau, who is not even another being, didn't recognize me?

[You seem like an incarnation I've never seen before, so don't meddle in things that don't concern you and just stay quiet. If you don’t want to get screwed.]

Not only that, the guy didn’t seem to remember me.

I thought it was a good thing.

"If I’m someone related?"

[What do you mean?]

"It’s my company’s business, so there’s no way it wouldn’t be related."

At those words, Yeonggi’s head suddenly turned toward Kyung Sein.

[Is this incarnation a new employee?]

Just before Kyung Sein shook her head urgently, I interjected.

"I just got hired. So I have the obligation to take on the company’s debt as well."

[There’s no way… There’s an incarnation that gets hired at a company like this? You’re joking, right?]

"Dokkaebi Yeonggi, does that matter now? You’re just going to collect taxes anyway, right?"

When I mentioned the guy’s name, Yeonggi’s expression changed once again.

[Huh, does a mere incarnation know me?]

"Uh."

[No, it seems like you don’t know. If you really knew me, you wouldn't act like that...]

Namgung Myung took a step toward me, perhaps sensing that the situation was taking a turn for the worse.

I raised my hand to him as a sign that I was okay, and continued to speak.

"You seem to be the one who doesn't know much. Are they teaching the Dokkaebis at the Management Bureau to act like that these days?"

Yeonggi looked down at me with a blank expression for a moment, as if he didn't understand what I was saying, and then laughed in vain.

But I'm also dumbfounded.

[How dare a bug...]

He even brought out his 'bug' repertoire, as if he were a successor.

"Why, you'll make my head explode?"

[Do you think you can't?]

"Have you forgotten which scenario this is? Do you still think this is a tutorial?"

A faint anger began to form in Yeonggi's two eyes. The power of the Management Bureau was in the guy's eyes, shining faintly.

[You're very confident. If you think that killing a bug will cause trouble when there are no Constellations to see—]

"Why do you think there are no Constellations to see?"

[What?]

The next moment, I let out a blast. A loud noise shook the entire garden.

There it was.

Kyung Sein, who was startled, looked back at me, and Namgung Myung, whose face turned pale, slumped down. Of course, the most surprised one was Dokkaebi Yeonggi.

[This is ridiculous…]

Yeonggi, who was startled, trembled and asked me.

[Oh, were you by any chance a Constellation?]

In times like this, it's best to just laugh silently like Kim Dokja.

[What? Why can't I see the relevant information… And the modifier… What on earth are you?]

It's probably because of the [Fourth Wall] that he can't access my information.

Yeonggi must be perplexed. A mere incarnation has the status of a Constellation, and it must be a situation where he can't even look up modifiers. I decided to help him out a little.

"If you're really curious, open the 'Dokkaebi Bag'."

Yeonggi listened to me obediently.

And after a while.

[H-how on earth?]

'Dokkaebi Bag' has a system that assigns 'membership levels' by referencing the Constellation's item purchase history.

And as far as I know, the level of my former sponsor, 'Demon King of Salvation's' Dokkaebi Bag is...

[Diamond level...?]

Yeonggi's eyes widened and he looked back and forth between the screen in front of him and me, exuding shock.

As expected, it seemed that the 'Dokkaebi Bag' level of the 'Demon King of Salvation' had been transferred to me.

I guess I'm seeing the benefit of having a good sponsor here too.

[Demon King of Salvation? The owner of this modifier must have already disappeared? Why do you have the right to use it...]

"You don't need to know that. I think this is enough proof that I have the ability to pay."

Yeonggi groaned as if he didn't want to admit it, then opened his mouth in a much more polite tone.

[Are you really going to pay your taxes in advance?]

"Yes. How many coins?"

Fortunately, I had quite a few coins.

However, the words that came out of Yeonggi's mouth were somewhat unexpected.

[100,000 D coins.]

Namgung Myung, who was next to me, shouted in protest.

"Wait a minute! There can't be that many! Last time, I'm sure…"

[You seem to have forgotten how much tax arrears there have been. All tax arrears accrue interest.]

"I know that, but…"

[The Management Office is not a poverty relief agency. And originally, you were supposed to pay 101,235 D coins, but since you, Diamond, specially agreed to pay in advance, I've reduced the rest.]

Yeonggi looked back at me and asked.

[Will you pay your tax arrears?]

"I don't have any D coins. Can't I just pay in coins?"

Then Yeonggi laughed.

[In this 'scenario area', only 'D Coins' are circulated.]

"Why don't you exchange the coins for D coins? What's the rate?"

Yeonggi's eyes started rolling at my words. Even at first glance, he had an expression that seemed to have an ulterior motive.

[If that's true, I'll exchange 10,000 coins for 1 D Coin.]

10,000 coins for 1 D Coin.

This kid must have learned how to catch people somewhere.

"Did we have coin inflation? The exchange rate can't be like that, right?"

[In principle, currency exchange is not allowed in this scenario area. This is also a suggestion I made because you are a Diamond member...]

No matter how much the coins rot, there's no way they would exchange them at that rate.

[Would you like to exchange them?]

"Would you?"

[Then let's just pretend that the tax payment never happened... ]

As if the results were visible, Yeonggi spoke with a shameless face.

I grinned.

Yeah, that's how you come out.

"I'll pay it. Before that, I have one question."

[Hmm? Go ahead.]

"What authority do you have to carry out this 'collection work'?"

Yeonggi tilted his head as if he didn't understand what I was saying and asked back.

[What do you mean? I'm a Dokkaebi in charge of the collection mission, so of course I have the authority to collect, right?]

"That's talking about other companies. It seems like the higher-ups didn't specifically issue a collection order to this company?"

The guy clearly said it with his own mouth.

The higher-ups are giving Kyung Sein's company a 'deferral close to special treatment'.

That meant that someone in the management office was 'looking after this company' so that they could defer their taxes.

[That's… ]

"I don't know where the guy who couldn't even properly explain the scenario learned such bad things and is acting like this..."

Yeonggi looked like he was hit with a sharp look. Looking at him, I somehow felt like I knew who the 'Dokkaebi who's looking after this company' was.

"Does Bihyung know that you're doing this here?"

At Bihyung's name, Yeonggi's face turned pale for a moment. I didn't miss the opportunity and continued to speak.

"It seems Bihyung doesn't know, does he?"

After hesitating for a moment, Yeonggi let out a faint sigh and answered.

[I don't know how you know that person, but even if you tell Bihyung, I can't give up on this collection.]

It was a stronger response than I thought.

Did he receive instructions from another high-level Dokkaebi other than Bihyung?

I thought for a moment and then said.

"Then give me a little more grace."

[How much...]

"A week."

[A week is too long.]

"Instead, I'll keep it a secret from him."

[…]

"I don’t know why the Management Bureau needs something like D-coins, but I can pay the taxes. I just want a little more time."

After thinking for a moment, Yeonggi answered.

[Okay. Since you seem to be close with Bihyoung, I will accept your offer. However, if you still can’t pay after a week, I will force the company’s executives to 'collect' the money.]

Yeonggi gave Kyung Sein a fierce look, then turned to me and said.

[I don’t know why someone like you is here, but I hope you have the grace of the story.]

With those words, Yeonggi disappeared beyond the swirling portal.

Namgung Myung looked at me with a somewhat impressed expression, and Kyung Sein looked at my toes with a complicated expression.

"Inho-ssi, you don’t have to go this far."

"I did it because I wanted to."

Kyung Sein’s eyes were red.

"Inho-ssi… why?"

"Why? We're colleagues."

"Why, why did you come now…"

As she was saying that, Kyung Sein's breathing began to tremble.

"Why, why on earth did you come now… Are you making me expect…"

Kyung Sein, who had been muttering quietly, began to stumble.

"Sein-ssi?"

I hurriedly grabbed Kyung Sein, who was falling forward. Kyung Sein's entire body felt hot as if it were on fire.

"Inho-ssi, you shouldn't get involved in this scenario."

"Wait a minute. Sein-ssi, the incarnation…"

I realized the moment my hand touched her. Kyung Sein's condition was so serious that I couldn't understand how she could have talked normally in such a body.

"If that happens, Inho-ssi too…"

With those words, Kyung Sein lost consciousness.

I felt Kyung Sein's pulse as she fell and checked the state of her hair.

Kyung Sein's hair was deeply damaged.

No, it wasn't just 'damage'.

It was like…

「A wound that felt like someone had ripped a part of her soul off.」

I laid Kyung Sein down neatly and held her hand.

Just by holding her hand, I could tell what kind of life she had been through. I felt like it was becoming clearer little by little what I had to do here.

I looked down at Kyung Sein who was sleeping and slowly opened my mouth.

"Gungmyung-ssi, how can I get something called D-coins?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 911 Episode 51 8 years (3)

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According to Namgung Myung, there were two main ways to obtain D-Coins in this scenario area.

One, obtain 'D-Coins' through the main or sub-scenarios that appear regularly.

Two, exchange 'D-Coins' for other items or stories through the 'Auction House'.

The first method could not be implemented immediately. So we chose the second method.

I headed to the 'Auction House' with Namgung Myung.

"There is another method besides this, but that is only possible for special people like you, Sein-nim..."

I felt like he was trying to hide the topic, so I didn't ask about it further. In fact, I could tell without asking.

「Dokkaebi Yeonggi tried to take a part of 'Kyung Sein's' soul.」

Thinking about it that way, it made sense that Kyung Sein's soul had been damaged. Kyung Sein must have paid the price of her debt in a similar way several times. But when I realized that fact, there were things I didn’t understand.

"Gungmyung-ssi, do you know anything about Sein's other colleagues?"

Kyung Sein said. The other colleagues were already moving towards the end in the upper scenario.

But did the colleagues I knew really agree to leave Kyung Sein here?

"I don't know much about them either. I'm embarrassed to say, but I was infected by Outer Gods during the invasion of the Fear Realm and was bedridden for several years."

The time when Kyung Sein and her colleagues were active was already 7 or 8 years ago. Therefore, Namgung Myung said he knew almost nothing about the Ascendants of that time.

"When I regained consciousness, my family had already been completely ruined. Sein-nim was the one who took me in when I was living on the streets because I couldn't adapt to the changed Murim."

"I see."

"Yes. However, I know about some Ascenders through rumors. For example, 'Flame Demon Emperor Star' who is protected by the Monkey King, and 'Black Wolf Cavalry' who carries the Archangel on his back are famous even outside of the New Murim District."

Flame Demon Emperor Star and Black Wolf Cavalry. Flame Demon Emperor Star is probably Ji Eunyu, and Black Wolf Cavalry is... Killer King?

I immediately tried 'Midday Tryst' on Ji Eunyu and Killer King.

['Midday Tryst' cannot be connected!]

Is it because the scenario area is too far to reach? Or maybe since they are in a higher scenario, it is too busy to receive Midday Tryst.

"Benefactor, we have arrived."

The entrance to the auction house soon appeared. As I entered the entrance to the auction house, I could hear the hawkers' calls from all over the place.

"Old martial arts books for sale!"

"Old martial arts equipment for sale in bulk. Come take a look!"

Among the items being sold on the street, there were famous martial arts that were familiar just by their names.

—Sky-Sovereign Sword Art.

—Three-Heart Sword of the Holy War.

Honestly, I was surprised.

'Sky-Sovereign Sword Art' and 'Three-Heart Sword of the Holy War' were exclusive martial arts of the old Five Great Families, and even among the descendants, they were things that only the direct descendants could learn…

—10 D coins.

But those martial arts were being sold for a mere 10 D coins?

"I wouldn’t be honored to meet my ancestors if I came here."

Namgung Myung tried to avoid eye contact with a bitter look in his eyes. That would make sense, because the 'Sky-Sovereign Sword Art' currently being sold at the stall was the representative swordsmanship of the Namgung Family.

Since such a martial art was being sold for such a low price, Namgung Myung couldn’t be at ease.

The martial arts books weren’t the only items being sold cheaply at the stall.

—Heavenly Iron Cloud Gauntlet.

—Heavenly Silkworm Secret Robe.

Although it wasn't a 'Black Heavenly Sword' level item, it was a famous item in the old martial arts world.

—15 D Coins.

Those items were being sold at prices that even I would find ridiculous.

I don't know about other items, but 'Heavenly Iron Cloud Gauntlet' or 'Heavenly Silkworm Secret Robe' would be worth buying for 15 D Coins.

If you give it to a person who is good at martial arts like Yoo Joonghyuk or Yerin, it would be very useful.

"Benefactor, I'm telling you just in case, but I don't recommend buying items from the Old Martial Murim."

I didn't plan on buying them anyway since I didn't have many D Coins, but I was curious as to why he was telling me not to.

Namgung Myung continued to speak.

"Items from the Old Murim are worthless in this area. In the 'New Murim District', items strengthened with D Coins are more powerful."

Come to think of it, there were quite a few weapons with 'D' in their names at the examination table.

"Items strengthened with D Coins greatly increase durability and power, and also increase skill proficiency. There is even a story that an unknown longsword strengthened with D Coins is stronger than a famous sword from the Old Murim era."

According to Namgung Myung, items strengthened with D Coins can only be dealt with by items strengthened with D Coins.

After hearing this, I think I understand why D Coins are so highly regarded in the 'New Murim'.

"Is the reason you came here, Benefactor, to exchange items for D Coins?"

"Yes."

"Do you have any items strengthened with 'D Coins'?"

"No."

"Then it will be difficult to get a high price at the auction house."

As expected, it was a difficult situation.

A total of 100,000 D Coins are needed to cover the company's debt.

But the D Coins I currently have...

[You received 5 D-Coins as a sub-scenario reward.]

That’s 25 in total.

I slowly looked around. As I looked, there were quite a few other martial artists in the auction house besides us.

I asked them while examining the symbols of their companies one by one.

"Are there any <Tamra Heavy Industries> people here?"

Namgung Myung, who didn’t understand the intention of the question, tilted his head and said.

"Huh? Of course, people from large companies do visit…"

"Then that 'supervisor' guy will come too."

The Monarch of Small Fries gave one D-Coin to a single hit. In that case, meeting that supervisor again and hitting him ninety-nine thousand, nine hundred and eighty times would be the fastest way to earn D-Coins for now.

Namgung Myung, who realized my intentions belatedly, said with a pale face.

"Benefactor, if you do that again, you'll be in real trouble. If you knew how scary <Tamra Heavy Industries> is a company..."

"Get out of the way!"

A group of incarnations pushed past Namgung Myung. Judging from the sinister aura flowing from their bodies, they were quite powerful.

Watching the martial artists of the area make their way, I checked the corporate symbols written on their backs.

—Vedass Biotech.

I wondered if there was anyone among them who had the 'Monarch of the Small Fries' as their sponsor. I watched their movements with some anticipation.

The group headed straight to the center of the auction house and soon stood in front of a machine that looked like a large scale. The scale had veins growing all over it and was writhing as if it were alive. It was an object reminiscent of the 'Fear' of the Fear Realm.

"Requesting an appraisal."

After a while, a screen that looked like a scoreboard appeared above the machine.

[The item appraisal begins!]

I saw the crowd of people gathering one by one.

"Oh, it's a new auction item. Did you get it from this collection?"

"It looks like it's from Vedas."

I and Namgung Myung also stood among the crowd.

"What is that?"

"Ah, it's the 'appraisal scale', a famous item at the auction house. It's usually used by people who want to appraise newly acquired items."

"What they brought doesn't seem to be an item from the Old Martial Murim."

"Benefactor is right."

Following that, I saw the man who seemed to be the leader of the group take out something like a small accessory from his bosom.

"That's the most valuable item in the 'New Murim'—"

The moment I saw the story embedded in the accessory, I thought I knew what Namgung Myung was going to say.

"It's an accessory from the Fear Realm."

The bizarre power unique to the Fear Realm flowed out from the accessory.

Only then did I begin to understand many things.

"Was Gungmyung-ssi in the Fear Realm at that time?"

"Yes. I also participated in the collection to obtain the parts."

"Why do they value those parts?"

"I don't know much about it, but I heard that the parts from the Fear Realm are the 'source' for making 'D Coins'."

The source for making D Coins.

Is this why we could hardly find any fragments Outer Gods in the Fear Realm?

"Oh, the appraisal results..."

The grade indicators spun like a roulette before my eyes. After a moment, the confirmed grade appeared on the screen.

[Natural Disaster Level.]

Cheering erupted from the area.

The incarnations of Vedas Biotech were seen nodding their heads with meaningful smiles.

"Oh my, a Natural isaster level?"

"Has there ever been a grade like that before?"

[The appraisal results for that part are 3000 D Coins.]

3000 D Coins.

The crowd was shocked at the huge sum that could be obtained by hitting 3,000 Takkongs.

"A mere 3,000 D coins for a single piece of tooth…?"

"If it's a Natural Disaster, then is it a piece of the 'shark' tooth?"

"It's already been two years since the last time a Natural Disaster-level piece came out. Hehe, Vedas Biotech has a big deal."

Then, [This Week's Ranking] was displayed on the electronic board.

1st place. A piece of a Natural Disaster-level Outer God tooth, Vedas Biotech — 3,000 D coins.

The incarnations muttered in envious voices.

"This week's ranking reward is Vedas'."

"That's enough to catch the eyes of the recorders. It's like he's guaranteed a super-fast promotion to the Executive level."

When Namgung Myung looked around, he was also looking up at the electronic board with envious eyes. I poked his shoulder and asked,

"Gungmyung-ssi, can anyone go and do the appraisal?"

"Yes, anyone with an Outer God attachment… Benefactor?"

As soon as I heard Namgung Myung's words, I headed straight to the front of the appraisal machine. I felt the incarnations of Vedas Biotech, who had just finished appraising, glaring at me with curious eyes.

I shrugged my shoulders and said to the guys whose eyes met mine.

"If you're done, please step aside."

As Namgung Myung hurriedly followed me and stood next to me, a small commotion broke out among the incarnations.

"What? They're appraising again? Which company is it?"

"Oh, that company…"

No matter how much the company has declined, there are still people who know its name.

"Hahaha, that's where the Namgung Family's small company is located."

"Is that person next to him a new employee? There's an incarnation that's joining that company?"

I looked around and saw Namgung Myung looking at me with expectant eyes.

"Benefactor, do you have any Outer Gods parts?"

Namgung Myung's voice was trembling.

I said to Namgung Myung, who was like that.

"Hmm, I was wondering if this could count."

On the tip of my finger, a strand of my hair that I had pulled out as a joke was caught.

Namgung Myung looked at my hair with unrealistic eyes.

I smiled and dropped my hair on the scale.

"Wait a minute! You can't put anything on the scale like that...!"

"Not just anything."

Just as the incarnations of <Tamra Heavy Industries> used 'Dionysus's hair' as a story, all the parts of Narrative-grade Constellations in this world have the power of 'stories'.

"That's my 'story'."

As I watched the hair falling on the scale, I thought of the Outer Gods I had met. Outer Gods that were Catastrophe-level, Disaster-level, and Natural Disaster-level.

「What is the 'most valuable' thing in the Fear Realm?」

If the criteria of this scale were the same as the grade criteria of the 'Transcendent Alliance'...

"He, he's crazy...!"

"What the hell is this guy coming in. He doesn't even know that if he misjudges an item, he'll be cursed by the scale—"

Soon, my hair touched the scale.

[The item appraisal begins!]

Seeing the colorful rays of light bursting out from the scale, all the incarnations including Namgung Myung opened their eyes wide at the same time.

"What the heck is going on?"

"The grade is displayed?"

The grades were changing in real time like a roulette wheel.

Catastrophe, Disaster, and…

"…Natural Disaster?"

"What is that… isn't the scale broken? This is ridiculous…!"

The moment someone's shock escaped, acrid smoke began to flow out from the scale.

「The greatest being in the 'Fear Realm'.」

I thought of the Second, who was sitting on a small chair and looking at me with a sad face.

「The understander of all Fears.」

The 'King of Fear''s rank as measured by the 'Transcendent Alliance' was as follows.

[End Grade.]

Along with the rank confirmation mark, the scale was covered in bright blue sparks.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 912 Episode 51 8 years (4)

"No, what's that—"

A commotion filled the auction hall.

"You didn't just see something, did you?"

"It's true. I saw it too."

"Does this make sense? The scale seems to have miscalculated."

The crowd raised their weight. Then the scale itself twitched, and a giant mouth-like thing appeared at the top of the scale.

[The appraisal result of the relevant department is 10,000 D Coins.]

There must have been a problem with the appraisal, because the message that came up wasn't very good.

Still, the result was clear.

"10,000 D Coins?"

A series of gasps of shock erupted from the crowd.

It was understandable.

10,000 D Coins for a single hair.

At this rate, it wouldn't be surprising if coin inflation occurred.

[Would you like to exchange the item you placed on the scale for D Coins?]

Can I exchange it right away?

"Exchange."

As soon as I agreed, the mouth at the top of the scale swelled abnormally and sucked in the hair. Then, with a whoosh, the scale's mouth began spitting out D Coins. The D Coins that poured out flashed towards me in a bright light and were absorbed.

"Wow, Benefactor… "

Namgung Myung's expression changed rapidly in real time. From bewilderment to shock, then to delight again.

I nodded and answered.

"It's easy to make money."

[The Constellation that 'Made Money By Selling Blood' is amazed by your price tag!]

10,000 per hair. If I just pull out nine more, I could even pay off the company's debt?

Hair will grow back anyway, so if I shave it all off, I could become the richest man in the <Star Stream>.

But there's one thing—

[The 'Settlement Scale' is looking at you.]

Since when? A pair of eyes sprouting from the scale were staring at me. I felt a sense of unease.

Where did the hair that this scale just devoured go?

Is it okay to continue settling accounts like this?

"You, what the hell have you done?"

A cold voice echoed in my ear.

I turned around, seeing the ones who submitted a tooth fragment earlier. The employees of Vedas Biotech, who earned 3,000 D-Coins, surrounded me with menacing expressions.

I smiled kindly and removed the hand on my shoulder.

"Just tell me."

But the supervisor, his expression hardening, threatened me once again.

"What did you do? How did you get such an appraisal?"

"You don't seem to know, but hair is precious."

It was a statement that would have made even the Great Jecheon nod, but the supervisor didn't seem convinced at all.

"Bullshit!"

The Vedas Biotech supervisor, unable to accept reality, drew his weapon at me.

I ignored him and stared up at the scoreboard in the air.

| |
|---|
| 1st place. ■?■?■?■?■?■?■?■?■? Hair — 10,000 D Coins. |

The rankings on the scoreboard had changed.

[The incarnation that takes first place in this week's appraisal ranking will receive an additional reward.]

[This week's appraisal ranking closes in one hour.]

I see, so this is why these guys are so angry. Basically, they're angry because their ranking reward was taken away.

"Just tell the truth. What the hell is that thing you brought?"

"According to the scale's description, it must be the hair of a End-level Outer God."

"There's no way an End-level Outer God could exist! They were all wiped out eight years ago! Catch this guy! He must have been involved in the illegal collection!"

It seems like it's not going to be a good idea.

Should I use [Incite] to take them out? Or should I show off my power and make them retreat?

I was contemplating which would be more effective.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who records <Vedas Biotech> is displeased with you.]

I frowned slightly and looked up into space.

Come to think of it, I'd heard the message from the Recorder who recorded <Vedas Biotech> and <Olympus Technology> before.

They were displeased with my entry into this 'New Murim District,' and immediately after hearing the message, the thugs from <Tamra Heavy Industries> attacked.

Wait a minute, so maybe even now?

"The Recorders ordered you to kill me?"

"Wh-what are you talking about?"

Their panic made it seem like it wasn't an entirely unreasonable assumption. I recalled something I'd briefly heard at the auction.

「"If it was that much, it would have caught the eyes of the recorders. Even executives are guaranteed a high-speed promotion."」

Most of the recorders in this city had titles related to companies like Vedas Biotech and Tamra Heavy Industries. Then, we can make this assumption.

What if each company had a 'Recorder' attached to it?

"Let me ask again. Did a 'Recorder' affiliated with your conglomerate order you to stop me?"

"It's none of your business—"

"Who is it? Tell me. The Demon King of the Cinema? The Fox Who Commands the Sky?"

For your information, the 'Demon King of the Cinema' was the alias of Asmodeus, and the 'Fox Who Commands the Sky' was the alias of Bicheonhori.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who writes for <Vedas Biotech> is startled by your remark.]

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who supports <Tamra Heavy Industries> asks how you know that alias.]

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who supports <Olympus Technology> questions who the recorder is.]

Hmm, I see.

Judging by the situation, it seems no recorder I've encountered in the 'Time Fault' has been present.

By the way, what on earth is happening that has the Recorders of Fear gathered in this city?

The Supervisor shouted indignantly.

"How dare you, a scamp, mention the aliases of the Great Recorders!"

The incarnations slowly surrounded me.

The sky then sparkled. The Constellations' messages came in.

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', is curious about your response.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald Leader of Justice', enters the channel!]

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', enters the channel!]

…

From the Recorders to the Constellations themselves.

There are too many eyes watching. With this much attention, resolving the situation by force is a bit burdensome.

I haven't yet confirmed the capabilities of major corporations like Vedas Biotech or Olympus Technologies, and revealing my strength first would only be detrimental. So—

"Well, I understand. I don't want to fight, so let's be honest."

Let's do this.

"First of all, this hair wasn't obtained illegally. I never participated in any collection or anything. Why don't you try using [Lie Detection]?"

As I raised both hands and spoke in a disinterested voice, one of the incarnations interrogating me activated their skill as if they had been waiting for it.

Then a message flashed:

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed your words are true.]

The supervisor, his expression hardening, asked,

"You didn't get it illegally? Then where did you get it?"

I calmly pointed to my head.

"Here."

['Lie Detection' has confirmed your words are true.]

"No way... How is your hair worth over 10,000 D Coins?"

"How could I possibly know that? Could the scale be broken?"

"The settlement scale has never broken before!"

"Really? Then let's check again."

I plucked four strands of hair in front of everyone and placed them on the scale.

"Request appraisal."

Faint sparks appeared on the scale, and the appraisal results were displayed.

[Appraising four identical parts.]

[The total value of the appraisals and purifications within the relevant parts is 40,000 D Coins.]

"Exchange."

D Coins poured out of the air.

I leisurely collected the coins, looking back at the bewildered men.

"It seems to be broken, doesn't it? Human hair can't be this expensive, can it?"

With [Incite] activated, I slowly looked around the crowd. Then, emphasizing each word, I continued.

"The <Star Stream> isn't perfect. I once obtained a bugged item from an item called a 'Random Item Box'."

「[Incite] becomes more effective when combined with truth.」

['Lie Detection' has confirmed your words are true.]

The crowd, once filled with distrust, slowly began to see a flicker of greed in their eyes.

I watched them for a moment, then grabbed my hair again and said,

"Well. Since no one seems to believe me, I'll continue the assessment…"

The supervisor, his face abruptly changed, pushed me and stood in front of the scales.

"Get out of the way!"

That was the beginning.

"Stop! I'll do it first!"

"No, I'll do it first!"

"I'll do it first!"

"Hey, don't push me! Don't push!"

In an instant, the area in front of the scales was filled with a crowd. Watching everyone, one after another, pluck out their own hair and place it on the scales, I quietly retreated to the outskirts of the auction hall with Namgung Myung.

From a distance, I could see the scale's mouth sucking in people's hair.

And a moment later.

[The 'Settlement Scale' has detected an abnormal emotional attempt!]

A strange message rang out.

The startled incarnations turned to each other and said,

"What? That guy from before is gone!"

"Wasn't that a bug? My coins—"

The mouth that appeared on the scale began spitting out the hairs it had sucked in.

The moment those who sensed something was wrong tried to flee,

[A fee will be charged for an abnormal appraisal attempt!]

[The 'Settlement Scale' is processing the settlement!]

The scale's veins twitched, and tentacles burst out from within its mouth.

"Kuaaaaak!"

The incarnations caught in the tentacles were flowing up the scale beam. They were all incarnations who had pulled out their own hair and placed it on the beam.

Among them was the supervisor who had picked a fight with me.

"What are you all looking at! Untie this now! Quickly!"

"What is this, what is this—"

[A fee will be charged for an abnormal appraisal attempt!]

The scale's mouth opened with the message. A thud, the sound of flesh crushing. Broken stories scattered everywhere, along with streams of blood.

「"An idiot came in. You don't even know that if you misjudge an item, you'll be cursed by the scale—"」

I guess that's what they meant by 'misjudged.'

"Aaaaaaaaah!"

The entire incarnation screamed in the midst of the horrific scene.

In an instant, the auction house was in chaos.

Only the starlight twinkling in the empty sky calmly observed the situation.

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', shows an expression of admiration.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', turns his gaze to the brutal landscape.]

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', is curious about your identity.]

[The Constellation, 'Lying Dragon', enters the channel!]

[The Constellation, 'Lying Dragon', asks what on earth has happened.]

[The Constellations of absolute evil support you with 20 D-coins!]

Along with the outpouring of support from the Constellations, angry messages from the Recorders also spread.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who writes about <Vedas Biotech> is furious!]

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who supports <Tamra Heavy Industries> frowns.]

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who supports <Olympus Technology> shakes his head.]

[The Recorders have begun the 'narrative agreement'!]

For a moment, my vision felt as if it were creaking, and a sentence appeared before my eyes.

「The auction house was in chaos. This was unthinkable. The hair of a mere incarnation was treated as the appendage of a 'End-level Outer God'.」

For the first time since leaving the Fear Realm, I was startled.

Sentences narrated within the colorless landscape.

「The Master of the Fear Realm died eight years ago, and every single one of his appendages was collected. However, the scale had just appraised the appendage of an

'End-level Outer Ood'. The meaning was clear.」

It wasn't my thoughts, nor was it a record of 'Ways of Survival' or the [Fourth Wall].

「The 'Settlement Scale' is broken.」

It was a scene similar to when I used [□□].

Someone was interpreting the reality before my eyes to their own liking.

「The incident was immediately transmitted to the 'Management Bureau'.」

The next moment, a powerful aftershock blasted from the scale, and it immediately ceased functioning.

[A new notice from the Management Bureau has arrived!]

[A 'Probability Appropriate Determination' will soon be conducted in the area!]

[The 'Settlement Scale' will be temporarily suspended while the 'Probability Appropriate Determination' in the area is conducted!]

The incarnations sighed.

"What? Was it really a bug?"

"Then what about that guy earlier! Did he benefit alone?"

"Where did he go?"

"Supervisor! Move the Supervisor!"

Having escaped early, I was hiding with Namgung Myung in a side street of the auction house, which had become a chaotic mess.

Namgung Myung, catching his breath, asked in a tense voice.

"Benefactor, what just now... was the scale really broken?"

"I don't know."

I stared at the message from the management office blinking in the air, thinking,

「There was no such thing as a bug.」

The reason my hair received a 'End-level' rating was because I inherited the story of the 'King of Fear.'

However, someone observing this situation was denying this fact and trying to attribute the situation to a 'scale malfunction'.

The reason was clear. They didn't want me to gain any more from this situation.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who writes <Vedas Biotech> looks at you with a displeased look.]

"Gungmyung-ssi, why are the 'Recorders of Fear' here?"

Namgung Myung's eyes slowly widened as he listened to my question, his thoughts racing.

"Benefactor, you were chosen by a 'Recorder of Fear'?"

"What are you talking about?"

"Oh... you weren't?"

Namgung Myung added, somewhat concealing his disappointment.

"I've heard that the 'Recorders of Fear' occasionally make special offers to incarnations who excel in the 'New Murim District'. In particular, those who quickly rise to 'Executive' status are often chosen by the Recorders."

The Recorders' choice?

It wasn't some kind of sponsor selection. Why would a 'Recorder of Fear' choose an incarnation?

This world isn't even a 'Time Fault' of the Fear Realm.

[You have attracted the interest of the 'Recorder of Fear' in that area.]

Huh?

[A small number of 'Recorders of Fear' are offering you a 'recording contract.']

[You can now choose the 'Recorder' who will record your story.]

Wait a minute, can't this be...

[If you accept the 'Recording Contract,' the 'Recorders of Fear' will personally record you on the 'Final Wall.']

[The 'Recorders of Fear' will spare no effort in completing an interpretation that benefits you.]

[Stories recorded through this contract will have their status greatly elevated in the <Star Stream>!]

Starting with that, countless messages flashed before my eyes.

[A Recorder, yet unsupported, wants to record your story.]

[A Recorder who enjoys large-scale fraud wants to record your story.]

[A Recorder who enjoys squinty characters wants to record your story.]

As I reviewed the suggestions from each Recorder, one message in particular stood out.

[A Recorder who hates regression wants to record your story.]

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

---

# 913 Episode 51 8 years (5)

I paused for a moment, rereading the nickname over and over again.

Like the Constellations, the Recorders also had their own modifiers. Just as Asmodeus was called the 'Demon King of the Cinema' and Lycaon the 'Prince of Wolves'.

However, before revealing their modifiers, the Recorders sometimes expressed their characteristics with simple rhetoric, as now.

「A Recorder who hates regression.」

With such a specific characteristic, the candidates that come to mind are narrowed down.

The first candidate is 'Yoo Joonghyuk' from the main story.

He was the first 'Regressor' to escape regression after repeated, distant regressions. Since he, too, acquired the 'Writer' trait at the end of the main story, it's possible he'd developed his powers as a 'Recorder'.

The second candidate is Han Sooyoung, author of 'Ways of Survival'.

She, too, likely wrote about regression tirelessly, so it wouldn't have been entirely surprising if she had used the rhetoric 'averse to regression'. The third and final candidate was the Monarch Slayer, Jaehwan.

As far as I know, he had also written his own story, so he could have acquired the trait of a 'Recorder' when he moved to the Star Stream.

But the fact that he would make this offer felt strangely unnatural. If it were the Jaehwan I knew, he'd be the first to attack me if he found something he didn't like...

Who could it be?

If this 'Recorder Who Hates Regression' is one of the three I predicted, then I wouldn't have much to lose by choosing this option.

The problem is if it's not one of those three.

What if there's a 'Recorder' with some nefarious intentions unknown to me, and he's using the rhetoric of 'hating regression' to deceive me...

"I won't choose a Recorder."

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name' chuckles, saying he knew you would do something like that.]

Then, the message from the Recorders came to mind.

[The Recorder of Fear who still has no support shakes his head.]

[The Recorder of Fear who enjoys large-scale fraud is disappointed in you.]

[The Recorder of Fear who likes squinty characters is intrigued by your choice.]

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who writes about <Vedas Biotech> glares at your choice.]

To tell the truth, I had no intention of accepting the offer, no matter who the Recorder was.

Because I, too, am qualified to be a 'Recorder of Fear'. I don't need anyone else's help in recounting my tale.

But Namgung Myung, unaware of this, looked startled.

"Benefactor, did you really refuse the Recording Contract?"

Instead of answering, I smiled. Perhaps sensing the ominousness in my smile, Namgung Myung began to ramble on.

"By signing with the Recorders, you'll receive incredible probabilities. You could win an impossible battle, or even escape the threat of your only life. So, if you're offered a Recording Contract, you should definitely…"

Every benefit of the <Star Stream> comes with a price. Especially if that benefit involves the most elusive aspect of the <Star Stream>: 'probability'.

Winning an impossible battle... It was a tempting offer, but I couldn't make a rash decision just because of the momentary temptation.

[You declined the 'Recording Contract'.]

[Some of the 'dreadful Recorders' are shaken by your choice.]

Tsutsutsu!

That's when sparks spread like ripples through the air.

[This guy's still the same. Did he choose no one again?]

A white head floated in the air.

I waved lightly at the Dokkaobi.

"It's been a while, Bihyung."

[Your 'Dokkaebi in charge' has been dispatched!]

The time for the 'Solo Meeting' has finally arrived.

---

'Solo meetings' with Dokkaebis take place in the 'Hat' each Dokkaebi possesses.

Is this Bihyung's 'Hat'?

A larger and more spacious space than the 'Dokkaebi' described in the main story. It was reminiscent of a hotel suite.

This must mean Bihyung's Dokkaebi rank has risen.

"You live in a nice place."

"Ahem, I'm a high-level Dokkaebi now."

The arrogant Bihyung quickly straightened and cleared his throat.

[Do you know why I called you?]

"More or less."

I was the last survivor of the 'Fear Realm.' During that time, I even traveled to another worldline through the 'Time Fault.'

"Isn't it because of the 'Returnee Scenario'?"

Normally, I should have already received the 'Returnee Scenario' and begun the process of returning. In the process, there should have been a resolution, either through a 'Returnee War' or by successfully persuading the group like Kim Dokja and regaining my true self.

[That's right. But there's a problem right now, so I can't activate the 'Returnee Scenario'.]

A problem?

[To activate the 'Returnee Scenario', I need not only the authority of the Management Bureau, but also the attention of the Constellations, and a certain number of 'Returnees'.]

"The authority of the Management Bureau shouldn't be a major issue, and there should be a way to secure the attention of the Constellations, so the final condition is the issue, I suppose."

Bihyung wiggled his eyebrows, seemingly intrigued by my answer.

[How do you know all that?]

As I shrugged without answering, Bihyung continued.

[You're right. I can manage to secure the authority of the Management Bureau and the attention of the Constellations, but... the problem is the 'Incarnations'. Right now, there are no 'Returnees' besides you.]

How could that be possible? In the <Star Stream>, a 'return' occurs on a fictional day.

[Recently, there was an event that summoned a large number of returnees. It was called the 'Return War' special…]

"I understand, but so what?"

[There was a crazy guy among the participants back then. He killed all the other participants. That's why the precious war and the scenario itself disappeared. Since that incident, the 'Returnee Scenario' has been temporarily suspended.]

Is there anyone among the precious ones who can wipe out all the returnees before me?

Who is it? Jang Hayoung?

[Anyway, that's why the 'Returnee Scenario' won't appear this time.]

I was grateful.

If a 'Returnee Scenario' were added to the current situation, it would be a hassle in many ways.

But Bihyung didn't stop there.

[Your next scenario will be a bit more difficult, though. Be prepared.]

"The reward will be that much better, right?"

["Well... but are you okay?"]

"I can tolerate difficulty adjustments as long as the rewards are good. But more importantly, could you please give me the scenario reward? I finished the Fear Realm and didn't get it."

["Oh, right. I should."]

Seeing Bihyung sweating profusely and looking into his pockets, I quickly added,

"Don't try to make up for it with some half-assed story. It's called the 'Fear Realm'."

Bihyung hesitated.

"You know what happened to me in the Fear Realm, right? I joined the 'Transcendent Alliance'. I defeated a Natural Disaster-level Fear, unleashed an End-level Fear... and at the end, you know that the Myth-level Constellations swarmed me, threatening to kill me, right?"

Bihyung hesitated for a moment before starting to search through his slightly larger pockets.

"If you think that's all there is, you're mistaken. You might not know, but I fought the Apocalypse Dragon in another worldline. If you know what happened there..."

I briefly absorbed the Apocalypse Dragon's shockwave, but the whole fighting the Apocalypse Dragon thing was a lie. If I had done something like that, I wouldn't be here now.

[This should do, right?]

I looked at the box Bihyung had pulled out.

> —An SSS-grade skill selection box.

It wasn't S-grade, or SS-grade, but an 'SSS-grade skill' selection box.

"Hmm."

I put on a disapproving expression, but honestly, I was astonished.

Even within the same 'SSS-grade' category, 'skills' and 'items' are on different levels. For example, items have a higher category called 'Relics' above 'SSS-grade', but skills end at 'SSS-grade'.

Even Yoo Joonghyuk's [Sage's Eye] was only an SS-grade skill.

And yet, an SSS-grade skill? And a 'selection box', at that. This wasn't a losing proposition.

"SSS-level skills? Are you really going to rule with something like this?"

But who am I?

"This isn't even worth exterminating a single Natural Disaster-level Fear?"

As a member of Kim Dokja Family, known as the 'Spout of Hell', I couldn't be satisfied with this small reward.

I had to get even a little more reward...

["Okay, okay. I'll give you that too."]

I honestly didn't expect another reward to drop. Considering Bihyung's aggressive nature, I thought even a SSS-level skill selection box was excessive.

"Another box?"

"I'll tell you after seeing the original."

I checked the name of the box Bihyung had handed me.

> —Limited Edition Random Relic Box.

The random part was familiar, but the name after it was surprising.

Relic? The relic I know?

> —It was recently made into a hack-only item, but was scrapped.

I nodded at the price written on the side of the box. Even if it contained a Relic-level item, I wonder who would buy it for 5 million coins per item.

And if the Relic level is even random...

"What kind of idiot would release something like this..."

Bihyung's expression darkened suddenly.

[Ahem, anyway. Is this reward enough?]

"It'll probably just contain a bunch of Historical-grade Constellation Relics."

[...I'll give you two.]

I knew it, you punk.

[You've acquired two 'Limited Edition Random Relic Boxes'.]

Yeah, this really wasn't bad.

Even if they're Historical-grade Constellation Relics, getting two at once isn't common.

After all, relics are strengthened by the user's story, so there's no need to worry about their level.

[So now...]

"Wait a minute, what about the coins? They were on the reward list, weren't they?"

Bihyung sighed lightly and shook his finger.

[You've earned a total of 2,000,000 coins as a scenario reward!]

I doubted my eyes for a moment.

Two million coins in one go?

It was even more than the reward amount.

"I guess the Management Bureau's finances are ample these days?"

[No, that's not true. I calculated it based on your achievements. You even defeated a Natural Disaster-level Fear, and you even had a showdown with the Apocalypse Dragon, right?]

"You didn't see me have a showdown with the Apocalypse Dragon, did you?"

[You said so. I believe you.]

"Isn't there some other motive?"

Bihyung's eyes rolled at my words. He really is an easy-to-understand Dokkaebi.

"If you're honest now, I'll let you off."

Bihyung looked at me and sighed, his heart sinking.

"Did you make another mistake? Or will a disaster descend upon Murim from now on?"

I began to float a scenario I could only imagine.

If a Dokkaebi like Bihyung were to unleash such a barrage of gifts, there would naturally be a plausible scenario.

In short, a great catastrophe, like a Natural Disaster slumbering in Murim, would awaken, or Yoo Joonghyuk, suddenly transformed into a beautiful girl, would awaken as the Demon King and wreak havoc...

But the words that came out of Bihyung's mouth were completely unexpected.

[Good job refusing.]

For a moment, I fell silent, unable to grasp the implications of those words. Then Bihyung sighed again and added,

[Refusing the Recording Contract.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 914 Episode 51 8 years (6)

I paused for a moment.

Is this kid praising me for turning down a Recording Contract?

"What do you mean by that?"

Of course, Bihyung was also a 'Dokkaebi' in the <Star Stream>. A Dokkaebi who wouldn't hesitate to throw in a bunch of incarnations for an interesting 'scenarios'.

He once sacrificed his life for Kim Dokja in the main story, but that was only a part of the main story.

In other words, Bihyung couldn't have said that out of concern for my safety.

[I wanted you to refuse.]

"Didn't you grumble earlier about not choosing?"

[We Dokkaebis don't like 'Recorders of Fear'.]

I hadn't heard a detailed explanation, but I felt like I understood Bihyung's feelings.

Basically, it was the Dokkaebis' role to preside over the narrative in the <Star Stream>. They exist to open channels, manage scenarios, and produce high-quality stories.

But when these idiots, devoid of any foundation, show up out of nowhere and start arguing, saying they'll 'record the stories', it's understandable they're not happy.

[Until now, the Recorders have been prohibited from directly interfering with the scenarios. Because if they interfere and start abusing narratives, the Probability of the story becomes a mess.]

That's right. Every single 'Recorder of Fear' I've encountered so far possessed immense power.

Asmodeus, Bicheonhori, Cheon Inho... If even one of them set their mind to it, even a 'Giant Tale'-level scenario could be distorted.

And indeed, they have.

[But recently, they've broken the taboo and begun to come to the forefront of the scenarios.]

"Recording Contracts."

[That's right. The Management is deeply troubled by that. This is the first time they've interfered with a scenario in this way.]

Even in Ways of Survival, there's no mention of 'Recording Contracts'. In short, what's happening in this city right now is unprecedented across all of the Star Stream's worldlines.

"So? What are you trying to say? Are you telling me not to sign any more Recording Contracts?"

["That's not all."]

Bihyung hesitated, his face uncertain whether to reveal this, then added:

["Do you... by any chance know how a Recorder of Fear is created?"]

I recalled a conversation I had with Bicheonhori.

「【I don't know exactly how a Recorder of Fear is born. Each Recorder has a different trigger.】」

Bicheonhori said.

「【Every Recorder becomes a Recorder for a different reason.】」

At the same time, Bicheonhori expressed all of those 'triggers' in a single sentence:

「Those who harbor the potential for a record worthy of the Oldest Dream.」

Of course, I had no intention of relaying that interpretation to Bihyung, so I shamelessly feigned indifference.

"I don't know."

The stupid Dokkaebi chuckled, as if he'd expected that.

[Then I'll tell you specifically. Most of the 'Recorders of Fear' are created by those lumpy guys.]

It was an unexpected answer, so I hesitated for a moment before asking.

"Can I use [Lie Detection]?"

[I swear on the Management Bureau.]

If that idiot Dokkaebi swears on the Management Bureau, it must be real.

[Some are born naturally, but most Recorders are mass-produced by those lumpy guys. They're often born when powerful people from worldlines that failed their scenarios communicate with the 'Devil of the Horizon'.]

"Why do those lumpy guys mass-produce 'Recorders'?"

[I can't tell you that.]

I thought for a moment and then answered.

"Are all the Recorders in this city mass-produced in the same way?"

[Anyway, you're a quick-witted brat.]

"I thought something was off."

Even in that 'Fear Realm', I only encountered four 'Recorders of Fear', but in the 'New Murim District', there were far more Recorders than the Fear Realm.

But if they were all mass-produced by the Recorderd, then that would make sense.

"What do you want?"

As if he'd been waiting for me to say that, Bihyung added with a feigned solemnity.

[The Management Bureau wants you to deal with the Recorders of the 'New Murim District'.]

"Are you asking me to kill them?"

[You arrogant brat, do you think you can kill the Recorders so easily? Just preventing them from advancing to higher scenarios is enough.]

"What should I do?"

[We just need to deal with the incarnations who signed the 'Recording Contract' with them.]

I see. So that was the true purpose of the 'Exclusive Meeting'.

I grinned and asked back.

"With my bare face?"

[This city's final scenario will begin soon. Whatever story you obtain here, I'll raise its rank by one level.]

It was a radical offer.

In other words, if I obtain a Legendary Tale here, its rank will be raised to Semi-Mythical, and if I obtain a Semi-Mythical Tale, its rank will be raised to Mythical.

For someone like me, who still lacks the rank to face Mythical Constellations, the increased rank of the story I'm about to obtain was a huge boon.

"Still, the risk is too great. Is there any other support?"

[I already gave you a generous reward. Full-scale support is out of the question. Even for the Management Bureau, it's difficult to intervene in this scenario area. The likelihood is too complex due to the intervention of the Recorders here.]

"If that's the case, I can't help you. If I fail, won't it make things even more difficult for the Management Bureau?"

[...I'll tell my superiors. You can receive light support if you want. If the likelihood of fallout is somewhat mitigated...]

"A tip, like how to deal with them? Like, if there's a place they only hang out in."

[You'd know better than me. You've probably seen other Recorders, haven't you?]

I said, recalling the high-ranking Recorders I'd met in the 'Fear Realm'.

"At least their faces."

["Hmm. I heard there's a subspace only Recorders can access... Well, I'm not a Recorder myself, so I don't know for sure."]

A subspace only Recorders can access?

It was quite useful information, so I decided to memorize it.

"Okay, I understand."

[So, you'll accept the request? I'll give you a sub-scenario?]

"Honestly, the reward is a bit disappointing."

[This guy really is...]

The reward was adequate, but since I was the one in control in this situation anyway, I decided to push it a little harder.

"No, think about it. In this scenario, if I obtain a Semi-Mythical or Mythical Tale, it's a gain, but if I obtain a Historical Tale, wouldn't it be a loss? Even if I raise the story level by one, it's only a Legendary one."

[No, there's no way the story you obtain here will be Historical. And a Legendary story is good, too...]

"Anyway, from my current perspective, there's no reason to clash with the Recorders. It's much more profitable to just sit back and relax before ascending, and that's why I've already prepared a Reincarnator's bus for that purpose."

[A Reincarnator's bus?]

"There is something like that."

Of course, I had no intention of just sitting back and relaxing before ascending, but still, it's all about the way you throw your cards.

I thought this would increase the reward by at least one point, but Bihyung's expression was surprisingly strange.

[Hmm. I didn't expect that. I thought you'd harbor a greater grudge against the Recorders than anyone else.]

"Grudge? What are you talking about?"

[Have you already forgotten what happened at the Recycling Center?]

I pondered what happened at the Recycling Center.

There, I confronted Lycaon, the fearsome Recorder, but I didn't particularly harbor any resentment towards him. In fact, I felt a sense of gratitude towards him.

[What? You didn't know until now, didn't you? You know the powers of the Recorders, right?]

I briefly recalled my encounter with Cheon Inho and answered casually.

"They're Recorders, so they'd record."

[That's right. When Recorders record the 'past,' it becomes 'history.' Then what if they record the 'future'?]

Recording the future?

[Anyway, you can't remember what happened back then. You're truly…]

My expression hardened involuntarily.

Future records.

I knew better than anyone else what they meant.

"Are you talking about [Fate]?"

A mischievous smile appeared on Bihyung's face. On the Star Ladder, and at the Recycling Center, I was sentenced to [Fate].

And in return for that Fate, I lost my Eldest Brother, and I even became an outcast.

A rage slowly began to boil deep within my heart. The image of my brother, repeatedly reduced to misery to fight that damned Fate, was still vivid before my eyes.

"The 'Fate' proclaimed by the Great Nebulae back then... does it have anything to do with the Recorders here?"

[Exactly.]

Bihyung laughed, his lips parted.

[Now, in this 'New Murim District', all the 'Recorders' who once wrote your 'Fate' at the request of the Great Nebulae are gathered.]

---

[You have accepted the new 'Sub-Scenario.']

After my private meeting with Bihyung, I stepped out of his cap.

[The Constellation, 'Bald Leader of Justice', asks where the hell you've been.]

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', whines that he too wants to see the Dokkaebi's cap.]

[The Recorder who likes squinty characters says that squinty characters are indeed full of secrets.]

The gazes of the Constellations and Recorders poured in as soon as I left. It wasn't surprising, considering I'd caused such an incident at the Auction House and then suddenly disappeared.

Bihyung's 'Dokkaebi Communication' rang in my ears.

—Then please take care of me. Contact me if anything happens.

'Bihyung, one last question.'

—What is it?

'Where are my comrades now?'

The information from the Recorders and the lump was important, but this was the question I most wanted to ask.

—I can't tell you. It violates the probability.

If the probability was limited even though he was merely revealing the location of incarnations, the reason was obvious.

「My colleagues have become beings of such great stature.」

After a brief silence, Bihyung spoke.

—Instead, I'll show you this.

A light finger snap was heard from somewhere.

[This week's Emotion Rankings have closed.]

[You have received the required reward.]

[You have received 500 D-Coins.]

A screen appeared beyond the D-Coins pouring from the air.

[Your Emotion Rankings will be recorded in the 'All-Time Emotion Rankings'.]

All-Time Emotion Rankings.

I checked the list before me.

As expected, there were names I recognized.

| |
|---|
| 3rd place, A Pile of Tentacles from a Natural Disaster-level Outer God, 9000 D-Coins, Kang Ilhun. |

Kang Ilhun, the name of Killer King.

6th place, the right and left arms of a Natural Disaster-level Outer God, 8,500 D coins, Lee Seyeon.

Lee Seyeon, Yerin's name.

8th place, part of the lower body of a highly damaged Natural Disaster-level Outer God, 8,100 D coins, Min Jiwon.

9th place, 85 low-damage Disaster-level Outer Gods, 7,800 D coins, Lee Dansu.

…

Even the names of the Editor and the Dansu ahjussi.

There lay the history of my colleagues. The history of their struggles and survival in this horrific hell.

The reason Bihyung showed this was clear. He was telling me:

See with my own eyes what happened over the past eight years. And as a latecomer, I must diligently follow in their footsteps.

Then, a message rang in my ear.

[Your current emotional ranking is '2nd'.]

[Would you like to register your name in the rankings?]

Emotional ranking 2nd.

That meant there was another person above me.

I checked the rankings again.

1st place, unidentified nail fragment, 10,000 D coins, ■■■.

The submitter's name was filtered.

I looked at the filtered name, and then again.

—Get a grip. This city's final scenario will begin tonight.

I nodded and said.

'Don't worry.'

At least in this scenario, I won't be the one who needs to get my head straight.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 915 Episode 51 8 years (7)

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Everyone has a favorite line from a story.

「Because 'I' am, after all, made up of things that aren't me.」

That line appears in chapter 252 of the main story.

The scene where Kim Dokja proves himself by being caught up in the 'real Kim Dokja' scenario.

When asked to choose his 'favorite scene', Kyung Sein always chose that scene. Even if no one else chose it as a memorable scene or line, he always chose it as one.

Whenever he saw his own memorable scene, which often received only one vote, Kyung Sein felt as if it had been written just for him.

Why did he love that scene so much?

「"Hey, bug."」

Was it because he'd been short since childhood?

「"Aren't you going to answer?"」

Or was it because his friends bullied him for being pale and thin?

「"Hey, stop harassing Minwoo. Do you want to get suspended again?"」

Or perhaps it was because he wanted to believe that all the realities surrounding him weren't 'real'.

「Across the countless fleeing 'Kim Dokjas', there was a man who knew the 'real Kim Dokja'.」

Kyung Sein pondered over that chapter for a long time, even writing it down somewhere.

He simply loved that scene.

He couldn't quite put it into words, but at least the Kim Dokja in that scene seemed to be speaking to him.

No one knows who you really are. Only you know that.

That's why Kyung Sein, who rarely read books, read that story to the end.

It wasn't as brutal as Kim Dokja's 'Ways of Survival', but it was definitely the novel he'd read the most in his life.

After finishing it once, he picked out his favorite parts and read it again, leaving comments, something he rarely did.

—I like Jung Heewon.

Perhaps that was the first online comment he left.

He, who had been afraid to even step outside his house, finally spoke out into the world for the first time.

And perhaps that one word changed his world.

—Will you come to our community?

People who were interested in his comments responded and invited him to join the fan community.

—But is your concept just to leave Jung Heewon comments all the time?

In the community, Kyung Sein could talk with people about his favorite novels. He learned how to debate and share opinions.

—But concept comments should be fun.

Perhaps countless Kim Dokjas taught him. How to speak with consideration. How to maintain eye contact when speaking. How to listen carefully before speaking.

—And before you joke, read the other comments.

The readers there taught him the obvious things his parents and teachers hadn't taught him.

He thinks it was around that time that he started exercising.

And strangely, his body began to grow. With each push-up or squat, his muscles began to grow.

As his size grew, the friends who had bullied him naturally disappeared.

Perhaps he was too amazed by this small miracle.

From then on, Kyung Sein would post photos of his muscles and write a comment about the day on the fan community every day. It was his way of surviving a life marred by minor tragedies.

"He's alive, right?"

And now, by his side were his comrades, each surviving in their own way.

"Of course he's alive."

A gentleman, yet warm-hearted, Dansu ahjussi.

"Don't worry. If he was in danger, there's no way he wouldn't have contacted me."

Killer King Cha Sungwoo, brimming with an inexplicable confidence.

"He's alive."

Cha Yerin, blunt but caring for her comrades more than anyone else.

"A new scenario will open soon. Let's prepare in advance, readers-ssi."

Even Ye Hyunwoo, calmer than anyone else, prepared for the future. Even though he possessed a character in a novel and faced death at any moment, he thought it would be okay as long as he had his companions.

He just had to read the end of this world together once more.

That was how it was, he believed.

「That day, before the 'Great Hall' opened.」

The day the 'Great Hall' opened in the sky, and 'nameless things' poured out from within. The day the Korean Peninsula's incarnations were annihilated in a scream.

The day when great Outer Gods they could never have imagined looked down upon Earth.

Perhaps, that day, the world of Kyung Sein ended.

The despair of never seeing the end of the scenarios. The fear that this world was not the 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 they knew.

"Dokja-ssi—"

Everyone cried out a name.

They knew he wasn't the Kim Dokja they knew. Still, they believed that if he was the 'Kim Dokja' they knew, he could solve this situation.

Tsutsutsutsutsu—

Then one day, a storm raged through the vast sky of the scenarios. A meteor fell from the sky.

"The protagonist has returned."

Killer King spoke those words, his voice as if possessed by something. It was truly strange. If Kim Dokja had returned, he would have said, 'Kim Dokja has returned', or 'He has returned'.

But Killer King spoke this way, 'The protagonist has returned'.

Behind Killer King stood someone.

「Kim Dokja was there.」

His face, his expression, his clothes—it was unmistakably Kim Dokja.

But at that moment, Kyung Sein knew. The phrase he loved was speaking to him.

The Kim Dokja standing before him now was—

"My name is."

It wasn't the Kim Dokja they had been waiting for.

"I'm ■■■."

---

With a deep exhale, Kyung Sein woke up. Her spine clenched from the cold sweat she had shed. It was all a dream. A dream from a distant time, when it was still acceptable for Kim Dokja to be called Kim Dokja.

"Ah."

Kyung Sein stared blankly into space before opening the notebook in her arms. It was the notebook she'd often open whenever she wanted to write something down. Crooked handwriting lingered on the notebook, long since it'd been opened for the last time.

I

ultimately

was not me.

The sentences she once loved now remained only in fragments. Kyung Sein couldn't recall the original form of those sentences, what they had been like.

The stories she loved were no longer in this world.

「"Sein-ssi."」

Kim Dokja, his face as pale as snow. With a calm gaze, the protagonist, who had perfectly solved every scenario that followed, spoke to her.

「"Please stay here."」

「"Why, why can't I?"」

She knows she's lacking. She knows her attributes are ordinary compared to her colleagues, and her skill proficiency is low. She trained and trained, wanting to become a tank like Lee Hyunsung, but she knew she still couldn't keep up with him.

Still, she worked hard.

She believed that if she worked hard, they would definitely recognize it.

「"We need someone to guard this place."」

There are stories like that in the world.

Like her muscle-building post, which was particularly unpopular, there are stories that, no matter how hard she writes, are rarely read.

「"Why do you say that? You—"」

She knew why Kim Dokja wanted to leave her here.

It was because she was weak. Because she wasn't helpful to the party.

But if that was the case, she wanted him to be honest. She didn't want to be left miserably like this.

「"I can do it too."」

So Kyung Sein said.

She spoke clearly, as if commenting on a story that had changed.

「"The Kim Dokja I know doesn't talk like you. You—"」

She knew she shouldn't say that, but she insisted.

「"You're not the Kim Dokja I remember."」

The next moment, she was standing on a pristine snowfield.

Amidst the flurry of snow that covered everything, he, the protagonist, ■■■, spoke.

「"Of course. Because I have no intention of becoming like that being."」

A pure white hand slowly approached.

「"Who on earth are you?"」

Kyung Sein was terrified of the being before her. This man, who called himself Kim Dokja, this protagonist, so different from her memories, she was terrified.

「"Someone called me 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'."」

A cold hand touched her forehead. Her mind felt tangled, and then she felt something being sucked out of her. She felt as if something she held dear was being taken away from her.

And after a moment, he withdrew his hand.

「"Isn't every fragment useful… Then, even if you collect a hundred percent..."」

An incomprehensible murmur.

Kyung Sein slowly knelt, exhausted. She didn't know what had happened. However, the moment his hand touched her forehead, she felt something like her essence tangled.

She was no longer the same Kyung Sein as before. Soon, a bitter cold washed over her.

「"I repeat. Please remain here, Sein-ssi. You do not need to proceed to the next scenario."」

In the biting cold, Kyung Sein nodded.

「"From now on, your existence has only one purpose."」

A talisman suddenly appeared before her eyes. It was a transmission pad. An item that sent messages from lower-level scenarios to higher-level ones.

「"Someday, 'he' will appear again in the scenarios. Then tear this paper."」

Kyung Sein nodded helplessly.

「"If you complete this mission, I will send you back to your original world after all scenarios are over."」

Kyung Sein slowly flipped through her notebook. Tucked into the end of it was the transmission pad she had received that day.

As she slowly picked up the transmission pad, the note hidden behind the talisman caught her eye.

「The real Kim Dokja.」

Those narrowed eyes she'd missed so much. His signature grin, as if he'd known it would happen.

Thinking back to that face, Kyung Sein felt like she was about to burst into tears at any moment.

"Why on earth…"

The person she'd once waited for more than anyone else.

But now…

"Inho-ssi, why did you show up now?"

The person she'd hoped wouldn't show up more than anyone else.

"It's too late now. Nothing can change."

Kyung Sein slowly picked up the paper.

All she had to do was tear this up. Just tear this up and tell him the truth, and her mission would be complete.

Her story ended here.

Kyung Sein fiddled with the transmission book over and over again with trembling hands, then sighed deeply. Then, biting her lip, she folded the book neatly back up and tucked it away in her notebook.

'I know I can't change anything.'

Just because he's back now, nothing will change.

The scenario is irreversible now. The 'being' that took the name of Kim Dokja is a great being that even the Constellations of that great nebula cannot approach.

The world is on the verge of ending.

And yet.

"This kind of scene doesn't exist…"

Kyung Sein staggered to her feet. She had to see him again. She had to tell him. He had to leave this city immediately, and that he shouldn't be promoted to a higher-level scenario. She had to tell him that.

Kugugugugu!

A sudden seismic wave. The house shook precariously.

"Executive!"

Namgung Myung, who had hurriedly opened the door and entered, had a pale complexion.

Kyung Sein nodded and stepped outside. A group of incarnations had gathered in front of the building.

"Is this the right place?"

"I'm sure. I heard he joined here."

"He's crazy. Of all the companies…"

The moment she saw them, she realized.

<Veda Biotech>.

They were incarnations of a major corporation.

"Be careful. They say the supervisor at <Tamra Heavy Industries> was taken by that guy."

"That must be because their supervisors are terrible."

"Oh, there you are."

The incarnations' attention focused on Kyung Sein's presence.

Kyung Sein took a deep breath and spoke.

"Great Heroes, what brings you here?"

"Huh, are you trying to play it safe?"

No matter how small the company was, Kyung Sein was still an executive. Yet, their attitude lacked the slightest respect for Executives. The Breaking The Sky Master, who had been lying on the floor, growled and stood up at the sight of such rudeness.

A man who appeared to be a supervisor from <Vedas Biotech> stepped forward and said,

"Give me back the D-coins you stole."

"What are you talking about?"

Kyung Sein wondered what he was talking about.

"You're not trying to play it safe, are you? I'm talking about the D-coins you obtained by exploiting a bug during the day! Because of that, I couldn't receive my ranking reward."

"I don't know what you're saying, but I think there's been a misunderstanding."

"You don't seem to understand."

The one who spoke was a man standing at the back of the group.

As the man slowly approached, the incarnations in the area parted like waves. The moment he confirmed the energy emanating from the man's entire body, Kyung Sein swallowed involuntarily.

'Executive level.'

There was no doubt. The being before him was an executive of <Vedas Biotech>.

A being with a high degree of attunement to the 'Narrative-grade sponsor', or perhaps a level comparable to the initial Narrative-grade.

In her current state, he was an opponent she could not face even if she were to revive from death.

"What happened for a Vedas Executive…"

"I was harmed by an employee of your company at the daytime auction house. I demand compensation for the damages."

As expected.

Kyung Sein asked, her expression hardening.

"Compensation, how much…?"

"50,000 D Coins."

Kyung Sein gaped at the unrealistic sum.

Why would they demand such a large amount of D Coins as 'compensation'? What kind of 'damage' would have to be incurred to justify such a large amount?

Perhaps that was why.

"Why are you laughing?"

Kyung Sein began to chuckle. The laughter soon grew louder, then more exaggerated.

"I asked why you were laughing."

Kyung Sein couldn't explain why she was laughing either. Perhaps she knew that this laughter would lead her to her death, yet she couldn't stop.

A strange sense of déjà vu kept creeping up on her. A premonition that something major was about to happen.

She knew this feeling well.

"I feel a strange sense of nostalgia."

It was fine if this was nothing more than a vain hope. Simply experiencing this sensation once more was enough.

"If you laugh one more time—"

"Why would someone laugh?"

It wasn't Kyung Sein who spoke those words. When did it start? A man stood on the fence of a house.

"She's laughing because you're funny."

It was a man with a narrowed-eyed smile, one that Kyung Sein knew very well.

—Inho-ssi.

Kyung Sein stopped laughing and sent a [Transmission].

—Run now. We must get out of this city.

But the man leaped lightly from the fence and landed beside her.

He saw the incarnations before him whispering.

"It's him."

"Really?"

The officer slowly raised his right hand.

"Deal with it."

And a terrifying wave of energy swept over the area. Before she could react, the Executive-level entity bombarded them.

Kyung Sein screamed and stepped forward.

But a lantern blocked her path.

Surprisingly, the owner of the lantern easily deflected the Executive-level bombardment.

The officers and employees shouted in shock.

The man, still not turning around, spoke.

"Don't worry, Sein-ssi."

It was clearly the back of the head Kyung Sein remembered. Nevertheless, the moment she saw it up close, Kyung Sein flinched slightly.

Even the automatically repairable 'Infinite Dimensional Subspace Coat' couldn't heal the sword marks.

Countless scars remained on his coat.

"Eight years."

Kyung Sein finally realized.

Just as eight years had passed for them, the man before him had also survived eight years somewhere. And finally, he returned to this story.

"I'm quite strong now."

The expression of the protagonist she had loved was there.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 916 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (1)

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The Recorder of Fear—the 'Unchanging One' had long forgotten his true name.

But even he, despite this, never forgot, and always remembered one thing.

It was the time when he first 'possessed' a character in this world.

He had possessed someone in the <Star Stream> 158 years ago, and just before he possessed, he was leaving a comment online.

The comment he had written was on an article about an actor's donation.

—No one knew. Yoo Joonghyuk had made several anonymous donations to an unknown organization...

The headline was designed to spark controversy. How could an article about anonymous donations be published without anyone knowing?

However, since a similarly critical comment had already taken the top spot, the 'Unchanging One' had no choice but to write a different comment.

—Isn't he donating to avoid taxes anyway?

Of course, the 'Unchanging One' had no idea whether donations were truly beneficial for tax savings. But since everyone else said it, he assumed it was true, and believed it was right. No. Whether it was right or not wasn't even his concern in the first place.

—What's so great about donating his surplus money? Isn't it all just image-making?

There are many reasons why the 'Unchanging One' would write such a comment.

It could be because he'd been studying for the civil service exam, receiving allowance from his parents for three years after his military discharge.

Or perhaps it was because he'd confessed to his only female friend at 2 a.m. a week earlier and been rejected.

Or perhaps it was simply because his mother, on her way to work this morning, casually suggested, "Why don't you try working part-time?"

Or perhaps he just didn't like the actor's handsome face that day.

In any case, the important thing was that the 'Unchanging One' left a comment that day, and even more importantly, someone had left a reply to his comment. "If you were born handsome, you could live like ash, right?"

But the 'Unchanging One' was a person who didn't know what was important in his life, so he wrote another comment.

"Yeah?"

Two simple consonants. Looking back, those two consonants changed his life.

"Crazy?"

The next day, when he woke up, something like a fantasy novel unfolded in his life.

[The main scenario begins.]

An apocalypse where people must kill each other to survive.

The 'Unchanging One' realized he had possessed someone in another world. Fortunately, with 15 years of experience as a webtoon reader, the 'Unchanging One' quickly realized his predicament.

"Abilities, what kind of abilities?"

Typically, these 'possession events' grant abilities.

The moment he looked in the mirror, the 'Unchanging One' realized what his abilities were.

"What the hell?"

He had become handsome. And his good looks proved quite useful as the scenario progressed.

He easily earned most favors, and despite his weak combat prowess, he was able to recruit party members without difficulty. Even his poor performance in the scenario led to some constellations showing interest in him.

The 'Unchanging One' chose the one that seemed the strongest among them.

[A constellation that Likes to Change Gender smiles brightly.]

Thus, the 'Unchanging One' became the embodiment of the 'Constellation hat Likes to Change Gender'.

Although he endured the humiliation of being forcibly gender-changed every three days, simply being able to have a sponsor was a great blessing.

He had to survive somehow.

Simply because the world had changed, the 'Unchanging One' devoted himself to his own survival, something he had never cared about in decades.

As he diligently killed people and plundered items, the 'Unchanging One' thought to himself,

Perhaps, here, he could live the life he wanted. He might actually become as great as the actor he envied.

"Supreme King! Supreme King! Supreme King!"

That's what he thought until he saw his face.

"Yoo Joonghyuk! Yoo Joonghyuk!"

When he first heard the name, the 'Unchanging One' couldn't believe his ears.

Why, why was that actor here?

On the other hand, he was also delighted.

Perhaps because his face had become more handsome than in his previous life.

The 'Unchanging One' mustered up his courage for the first time.

"Are you possessed too? It's me!"

"..."

"You're Yoo Joonghyuk, right? You donate a lot... I'm a fan!"

Yoo Joonghyuk glanced at him with his golden eyes, then continued on his way without paying him any attention.

After that, the 'Unchanging One' never saw Yoo Joonghyuk again.

Perhaps it was only natural. The 'Unchanging One' was desperately struggling to survive in the lower scenarios, while Yoo Joonghyuk was a monster, fighting fearsome constellations as he moved from one scenario to another.

Even when the environment changes, humans don't change. He may have become handsome, but he was still the 'Unchanging One'.

And instead of chasing Yoo Joonghyuk, who had turned his back on him, the 'Unchanging One' chose to remain in the lower scenarios, resenting and cursing him.

"I knew you'd be like that, you piece of trash!"

When Yoo Joonghyuk was attacked by giant nebulae and destroyed in scenario 73, the 'Unchanging One' thought his wish had been granted.

But the 'Unchanging One' didn't know.

What the protagonist's death in this world would mean to an extra like him.

[That's the end of your story. It's been fun, poor child.]

Everyone. The scenarios failed, and the universe perished.

He prayed his sponsor.

I want to live. I don't want to die like this."

His sponsor smiled and said,

[Don't worry. Your usefulness doesn't end here. You've lived the life you wanted, so now pay the price of your contract.]

And when he came to his senses, he received the following message,

[You have successfully concluded a contract with 'Wenny Man'.]

[You have become a 'Recorder of Fear'.]

[Your modifier is 'Unchanging One'.]

Thus, the 'Unchanging One' became a 'Recorder of Fear,' floating through worldlines under the orders of the 'Wenny Man.'

And now, you, reading this story, are probably wondering:

Why on earth do I have to read 3,013 characters of this 'Unchanging One's' story?

The reason is simple.

Because the 'Unchanging One' is thinking about his own records in real time.

"How long do I have to keep recalling these records?"

In case the 'Oldest Dream' were to pry into their hearts, all 'Recorders of Fear' were obligated to constantly recall their history in a corner of their minds.

Of course, the 'Unchanging One' was certain that the Supreme Being would not pry into them, but it was still a possibility.

'If I record this scenario well, I too can rise to a higher scenario.'

Every 'Recorder of Fear' rose in stature the more magnificent the story they recorded.

'Goodbye to this tedious Murim.'

The mission he received from the Hunchback was to assist the ascension of an incarnation from <Vedas Biotech>.

He had signed a recording contract with <Vedas Biotech> executive 'Yoon Hyunseok' and was tasked with recording him.

「Executive of <Vedas Biotech>. King of the Hell Yoon Hyunseok. The contracted constellation is 'Parrot of Desire'.」

The constellation's description was a bit odd, but it was nonetheless a Narrative-grade constellation of <Vedas>.

Indeed, Yoon Hyunseok was a powerful figure, not only nicknamed 'King of the Hell', but also occasionally mentioned in 「The 100 Strongest People」, written by the high-ranking Recorder, 'The Fox Who Commands the Sky'.

In other words, from the perspective of the 'Unchanging One', Yoon Hyunseok was a convenient figure who 'could be written roughly'.

「Executive Yoon Hyunseok frowned and glared at the unidentified man. He had narrow eyes and a pale face, and he was someone he didn't like at all.」

To be precise, that was the case until a moment ago.

「Yoon Hyunseok pursed his lips and thought, 'He withstood my [King of the Hell Fist]? There's no way that's possible.'」

Yoon Hyunseok was an Executive-level incarnation, considered a potential next ascendant alongside <Olympus Technology>'s Reinheit and <Black Cloud Foundation>'s Cho Jicheol.

The incarnation of a small business, a first for him, blocked the Executive's attack.

'What is this?'

「King of the Hell Fist was the highest-level martial arts skill possessed by <Vedas Biotech>. It was definitely not a skill a random incarnation could block.」

「The narrow-eyed man grinned as if nothing had happened.」

The 'Unchanging One' glared at the narrow-eyed man, wondering.

Does he have a backer?

He'd suspected something was off from the start. Why would he suddenly show up and visit the <■■■ Company>? Why would he appraise the hair of an 'End-level Outer God'

at an Auction House? The Auction House incident, in particular, was so improbable that the 'Unchanging One' had to work with the other Recorders to dismiss it as a 'bug'.

'There's no way he could have emerged from the Fear Realm.'

As far as the 'Unchanging One' knew, the only incarnation to return from the Fear Realm eight years ago was the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'.

To stop the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint from running wild, all the Recorders in the city had to work together to enforce the 'Record'. As a result, the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was now imprisoned in the city's underground prison.

'Then is he an irregular like the Mad Sword Emperor?'

Pulling his lips tightly, the 'Unchanging One' concluded.

'Whatever he is, I will eliminate him here and now.'

Although he lacked the penmanship of the high-ranking Recorders who once existed in the Fear Realm, the records he wrote possessed a probable, compelling force, akin to a small fate.

['Record' begins!]

Especially when a powerful figure like Yoon Hyunseok was the subject, his power grew even stronger.

「Yoon Hyunseok glared at the narrow-eyed man for a moment before gathering his composure. The fact that he hadn't collapsed despite being struck by his Hades's fist meant that his opponent possessed at least the strength of a supervisor—perhaps even an executive.」

Just like the day he left a comment on Yoo Joonghyuk's article, the 'Unchanging One' continued writing without even realizing what he was writing.

「He decided not to let his guard down. From now on, he's assuming his opponent is an 'Executive' level.」

In fact, Yoon Hyunseok was already strong enough even without this. He was a powerful figure in the early stages of the Narrative-grade, capable of drawing on up to eighty percent of the power of his sponsor.

With the help of the Recorder, this powerful man began to unleash his full potential.

「'I'll activate [King of The Hell Sacred Method] to its fullest potential and finish him off with [King of The Hell Fist]'s transcendent secret technique, [King of The Hell Sovereign of the Pure Garden].'」

「'If not twice, I'll use it three times. If not three times, I'll use it four times. I won't let my guard down even in the slightest.'」

「Yoon Hyunseok's [King of The Hell Fist] swept through the entire estate. Thick smoke rose. It was a brutal bombardment, leaving not a single ant to survive.」

The 'Unchanging One' nodded.

As expected, his handwriting is exquisite.

He continued writing, concluding.

A sentence that determines the character's life or death.

It was time to write his favorite scene.

「The corpse of a man with narrow eyes, horribly torn apart...」

That's when something strange happened.

「...Yoon Hyunseok smiled bitterly, anticipating what lay scattered everywhere.」

'What?'

That wasn't the sentence he had intended to write. He clearly intended to write, 「The horribly torn, narrow-eyed man's corpse lay scattered everywhere.」

The Unchanging One furrowed his brow and attempted to write again.

「The thick smoke cleared, and the horribly dismembered corpse of the narrow-eyed man…」

Tsutsutsutsu!

「…Yoon Hyunseok smiled bitterly, anticipating what would unfold before his eyes.」

The 'Unchanging One' gaped blankly.

The sentence he had just been about to write was, 「The thick smoke cleared, and the horribly dismembered corpse of the narrow-eyed man came into view.」

But then another strange sentence appeared.

And that wasn't the end.

Sentences continued to appear randomly.

「Yoon Hyunseok thought, 'Did it harm him?'」

It was a sentence he had never written before.

「The thick fog cleared, and the narrow-eyed man appeared, unharmed.」

The 'Unchanging One' stared blankly at the continuing record, his fingers beginning to tremble.

The sentences he had desperately written were disintegrating, and new sentences were being typed on top of them.

「The narrow-eyed man, who had been smiling faintly, slowly opened his eyes.」

The record had escaped his control.

The significance of this fact was clear.

「The man's gaze was clearly focused on Yoon Hyunseok. He was heading towards him, but what he was seeing wasn't Yoon Hyunseok.」

To that narrow-eyed man before his eyes—

「"Were you there?"」

An even more powerful 'Recorder of Fear' was attached to him.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 917 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (2)

I'd fought a Recorder of Fear before. To be precise, it wasn't me; it was the combined efforts of the Demon King of Salvation and Yoo Joonghyuk.

Cheon Inho, in the 40th Round.

I tried to recall his fighting style.

Cheon Inho, a high-ranking Recorder nicknamed 'The One Who Deceived the Stars', had never manifested 'powers' like this before.

「Yoon Hyunseok, calming down his confusion, reconsidered his thoughts. He's strong. At least 'Executive level.' Perhaps even strong enough to rival the 'Ascendants.' But how could that be? Someone who only recently entered the city could be strong enough to rival the Ascendants?」

Sentences flowed hurriedly before my eyes. Naturally, they weren't mine.

「That can't be true. If there were such an incarnation, he would have been chosen by a 'Giant Nebula' and summoned to the higher-level scenarios long ago.」

I'd seen him somewhere before, and the flow of his sentences was plausible.

With this flow, the conclusion of the story he was trying to tell was clear.

「The narrow-eyed man in front of me is definitely using some kind of trick.」

Tsutsutsu, I felt the sentences he had written cling unpleasantly to my body.

「The power to record fate.」

The power to 'realize' the sentences he had written.

Thinking back, Asmodeus, who had taken over the 'movie theater', possessed similar reality-altering abilities.

And crucially.

[Special skill, '□□', twitches.]

My [□□] possessed a similar power.

"Die!"

An Executive from <Vedas Biotech>, imbued with demonic energy in both hands, launched a flanking attack. [King of The Hell Sacred Method], [King of The Hell Fist], and even the secret technique [King of The Hell Sovereign of the Pure Garden].

On the surface, it was a repetition of the attacks he had unleashed earlier, but the words behind it were different.

「Yoon Hyunseok's lungs heaved deeply and heavily, and the breath he inhaled filled his body, boiling as if ready to explode at any moment. His eyes flashed with an unfamiliar color, transcending the enemy before him, and every sound that brushed his ears became distant and faint, like dull ripples in water.」

Wow.

「Yoon Hyunseok slowly clenched his fist. Each knuckle cracked, and thin, blue veins crawled up the back of his hand like living snakes.」

Even its name was a weighty and solemn martial art—[King of The Hell Fist]. A single, annihilating blow that completely devours and destroys a person's existence."」

Looking at the rambling sentences, I couldn't help but be amazed.

It's been a long time since I've seen such a 'brick paragraph'.

Kugugugugu!

The [King of The Hell Fist]'s powerful wind pounded my entire body like a drum, accompanied by a thunderous sound.

"Kuaaaah! Executive!"

The excited man seemed oblivious to the fact that his fellow <Vedas Biotech> subordinates were being blown away by the powerful wind.

「How much of a blast did he unleash? Yoon Hyunseok, standing in the dust-filled courtyard, muttered.」

"Did I harm him?"

「For a moment, Yoon Hyunseok flinched. 'Why did I say something like that?'」

'Because I wrote it.'

As if I had been waiting, I dusted myself off and stood up, and Yoon Hyunseok looked genuinely flustered.

[The story, 'Rewriter of Fate', lets out a loud cry!]

I survived the fate of those 'Giant Nebulae'.

If I, who am so desperate, can't overcome a few sentences scribbled by a single Recorder, that's absurd.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' writing 'Vedas Biotech' is astonished.]

[The 'Recorder of Fear' writing 'Vedas Biotech' surreptitiously glances around and calls out to another 'Recorder'.]

Another Recorder?

"Inho-ssi, run."

Kyung Sein, who had been observing the situation from behind me, stepped forward.

"The Executives aren't simply scary because they're strong. Inho-ssi, you might not know this, but each of those guys has a 'Recorder' attached to them."

I nodded in understanding. But perhaps thinking I hadn't fully grasped it, Kyung Sein continued.

"Right now, there's only one Recorder, but if they increase, even Inho-ssi won't be able to stop them. I'm fine, so run. The other Executives will soon come rushing in. If the Recorders gather and [Fate] is unleashed—"

"It's fine."

"That's what Inho-ssi says without knowing! [Fate] is…!"

"I know. [Fate] is so damn annoying."

A thunderous clap of thunder ripped through the air. The next moment, the eastern sky seemed to flash, and two figures soared through the air. Kyung Sein's face, seeing their faces, was tinged with despair.

As if to add to Kyung Sein's expression, Namgung Myung spoke.

"Benefactor, these are the next Ascendants of <Vedas Biotech>."

The Ascendants. Incarnations of the same caliber as Cho Jincheol and Reinheit had appeared again.

"Did you summon us, King of The Hell?"

"You've created another troublesome situation."

On the surface, it seemed like a normal conversation, but I could read the exchanges taking place behind the scenes between the recorders.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' who writes <Vedas Biotech> reveals his alias!]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', asks for help!]

As Kyung Sein had said, each Executive-level figure had a 'Recorder' attached to them.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Writes Youth', responds to the call for help.]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Doesn't Like Twists', responds to the call for help.]

"Hmm, I've seen him somewhere."

"Could it be that you couldn't handle that one kid on your own?"

The King of the Hell, Yoon Hyunseok, frowned and retorted.

"Don't underestimate him. He withstood my [King of the Hell Fist]."

"King of the Hell Fist?"

For a moment, I saw the three Executives exchange glances. A moment later, Yoon Hyunseok stepped forward again and asked me,

"What is your identity?"

"I'm an employee of this company."

"Who asked you that? How come you're under the protection of a 'Recorder'? Are you dispatched from a Giant Nebula?"

It seems the Recorder, known as the 'Unchanging One,' has already spread word about me.

I feigned a shrug and said,

"I'm affiliated with a Nebula, of course."

"Which Nebula?"

"<Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint>."

The three men frowned again.

"Are you kidding us? I've never heard of a nebula like that."

I gave a wry smile. Still, they were Executives, so they were quite clever. They realized I had a hidden plan, so they were deliberately stalling.

[The Recorders of Fear are starting a 'Record Discussion'!]

The Recorders are probably trying to buy time to declare their definitive [Fate]. Of course, I had no intention of leaving it that way.

"Stop wasting time. Isn't this what you all came here for anyway?"

I held out my hand in the air and showed the D Coins I'd accumulated.

The D Coins emitted a dazzling light into the air, and the Executives' expressions changed.

"So there was a reason the King of the Hell called us."

"You were trying to keep all that for yourself?"

King of the Hell Yoon Hyunseok frowned at the Executives' rebuke.

"If you help me now, I'll divide it into three equal parts. I've already spoken with the Recorders."

"Good. But are you seriously planning a fight here? The other companies will notice."

"I asked the Recorders to set up a barrier."

Namgung Myung warned about the Executives, watching them slowly approach.

"Benefactor, be careful. I heard that with three Executives, they can hunt even 'Disaster-level Fears.'"

Disaster-level Fears.

"They're a little stronger than Kim Anna."

"Huh?"

"Stand back, Gungmyung."

At the same time, the officers charged.

A pure, magical barrage, unconcealing their own power.

It was a crude, unpolished fighting style, devoid of any subtlety, but there were plenty of them at the Narrative-level.

This is probably why, as scenarios progress, the difference in 'power' becomes a distinct difference in 'combat power'. Most incarnations would lose their fighting spirit the moment they saw the difference in power.

"You're a clever guy."

When I used [Way of the Wind] to evade the barrage, the officers' expressions became even more serious.

I calmly observed them. There were three officers in total. However, they were assigned two constellations.

[The constellation, 'Desiring Parrot', is observing you closely.]

[The constellation, 'Horse-Possessing Twins', senses a strange sense of deja vu in your fighting style.]

'Desiring Parrot' and 'Horse-Possessing Twins'. Although they hadn't appeared in the main story, they were constellations from Vedas, familiar to me through 'Ways of Survival'.

The 'Desiring Parrot' was Kamadeva, the god of love and desire.

And the 'Horse-Possessing Twins' were the 'Ashvin Twins'.

Since the twins were literally 'twins', it seemed they had struck a pact with the two Executives.

"How long do you think you can keep running away like that?"

"Aren't you just missing him?"

Since both constellations were 'Narrative-grade', if I gave them time, they might be able to deduce my identity.

I decided to change my strategy.

"Honestly, I'm a bit disappointed. I thought an Executive-level constellation would at least have a 'Lokapala'-level constellation."

[The constellation, 'Desiring Parrot', rages and increases its synchronisation with the incarnation!]

[The constellation, 'Horse-Possessing Twins', rages and increases its synchronisation with the incarnation!]

As the constellations began to reveal their powers, the recorders also seemed to be elated.

「As 'Kamadeva' raged and displayed his power, the 'Ashvin Twins' also revealed their true colors. How dare a mere incarnation mention the great 'Lokapala' and mock them? As a Constellation of <Vedas>, it was an unbearable shame.」

The feast of power exploded. Despite the pressure I was experiencing, I refused to back down or cower.

「Perhaps this fight will be my comeback.」

Until now, I had been conserving my energy to gauge their strength, but from now on, I no longer needed to.

「The [Soundproof Barrier] hanging over the area was blocking out the commotion.」

That's because those greedy 'recorders' were thoroughly concealing the story here, lest the other recorders and Constellations discover it.

[The constellations on the temporary channel are curious about what's happening in that area!]

It seems they even obscured the channel.

For me, it was a good thing.

「<Vedas Biotech>'s power began to gather. The power of each Executive was on a different level. Soon, the three incarnations, who had reached the early stages of Narrative-grade, filled the entire estate with their power.」

The full narrative of these men unfolded before my eyes, and the three Executives launched a combined barrage.

It had begun.

「The story of the 'Desiring Parrot' was included in [The Underworld]...」

「The story of the 'Horse-Possessing Twins' permeated the Executives' strength...」

The power of the 'Narrative-grade Constellations', with a synchronization rate of over eighty percent. In the past, simply seeing them up close would have been a breathtaking sight.

Taking the handle of 'Unbreakable Faith' from my waistband and gripping it, I recalled Han Sooyoung's words.

「"The ones you'll face from now on will be at least Narrative-grade Constellations."」

I was in no position to become as powerful as the other incarnations. Because I had lost my sponsor, and despite collecting five legends, for some unknown reason, I hadn't been granted the 'Stage of the Constellation'.

I had collected quite a few high-level stories, and even a fair amount of 'Kim Dokja Fragments', but I didn't know how to utilize them properly. That was me before I met Han Sooyoung.

「"Just one moment is enough. If you're stronger than them for just one moment, you'll win."」

So, when I asked how I could create that one moment, Han Sooyoung replied, looking at me as if I were pathetic.

「"You're 'Kim Dokja,' aren't you?"」

The moment I slowly blinked, a story began in my head.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', purses his lips and complies with your request.]

[The story, 'King of a Kingless World', begins its storytelling.]

Until now, I could only borrow one story from Heir at a time.

[The story, 'He who stands against treachery', begins its storytelling.]

However, after the 1,863rd Round, I learned how to draw out a little more of his strength. For example,

[The story, 'One Who Hunted the King of Disasters', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'One Who Slaughtered the Deity of the Otherworld', begins its storytelling.]

For example, drawing on five 'Kim Dokja stories' at once.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', begins its storytelling.]

Due to the excessive amplification of stories, a storm of probability began to ripple through my incarnation body.

"W-what...!"

The astonished Executives cried out.

The five stories within me shone brightly and aligned.

「This is the power of a forgotten star.」

The 'Demon King of Salvation' no longer existed in the <Star Stream>. However, that didn't mean the story of the 'Demon King of Salvation' had disappeared.

In a single moment, a method to unleash the power of the 'Constellation' through the body of an 'Incarnation.'

[The 'Forgotten Constellation' is re-embodied upon your flesh!]

The constellation that destroyed the Absolute Throne, slaughtered the returnees, defeated a calamity of the level of a Narrative-grade, slew the deity of the other world, and eventually ascended to the throne as the 73rd Demon King.

「"It's quite something? That's enough..."」

The constellation's heyday was being rewritten through my flesh.

「"It'll be at least as good as a Narrative-grade."」

With Han Sooyoung's words flowing through my mind, a storm of Baekcheong swept through the entire estate.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 918 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (3)

A suffocating storm of white and blue struck the manor.

The three Ascendants, their faces paling, simultaneously dodged.

A spark of probability erupted eerily from the dust.

Sentences then emerged.

「This power? Could that Constellation be...?」

「That can't be. That Constellation must have died then!」

「Nonsense...!」

Sentences that seemed to be the inner thoughts of the Recorders. They didn't seem to have been written directly by them; perhaps they were part of their subconscious.

"Everyone, wake up! The record is leaking!"

The 'Unchanging One' warned, and the intermittent lines of text abruptly cut off.

"Don't panic! It's the same as a Narrative-grade! And there are three of us!"

Perhaps not yet fully grasping the situation, the Ascendants seemed to be regrouping. I said to those guys.

"They're not the same Narrative-grade."

Five stars shining from my entire body. I gradually drew on the power contained within the Constellation.

[Your incarnation is overloaded!]

Power acquired after enduring the 1,863rd Round with Han Sooyoung.

AKA 'Demon King of Salvation' mode.

Use time is approximately 5 minutes.

Instantaneous combat power is 'late stage of Narrative-grade.'

"Wh, what... the level keeps rising!"

"Don't be intimidated by the level alone! I've heard information about that guy! That Constellation's combat prowess isn't that great compared to its level!"

I was a little surprised by the accuracy of the information.

As he said, the 'Demon King of Salvation' didn't have great combat skills compared to his level.

But the reason the 'Demon King of Salvation' is so scary isn't because of his 'powerful techniques'.

"Heir-ah, I'll borrow another story."

With a tsutsutsu, a new story was added to the constellation.

[The story, 'Insect Massacre', begins its storytelling.]

Story 「Insect Massacre」.

A story that unleashes overwhelming power when the opponent is 'weaker' than the story's owner.

The sphere surrounding my incarnation body began to glow even brighter.

[This story resonates with the constellation 'Demon King of Salvation'!]

The reason the Demon King of Salvation is so terrifying is because his story affinity is unparalleled among other Constellations.

The story's power, instantly activated, took control of the entire area through my body.

"That's—"

The Ascendants, recognizing the story, retreated.

But it was too late.

In a flash, Baekcheong's sword swung, slicing off the head of one ascendant.

"First, one."

Even if it were the 'Insect Massacre' unleashed by the 'Demon King of Salvation', this story, born of 'Historical-grade' origins, wouldn't work well against beings possessing a certain level of power.

For example, with someone like Yoo Joonghyuk, who had only faced overwhelmingly stronger opponents, 'Insect Massacre' couldn't fully demonstrate its capabilities.

But the ones before me were different.

"R-R-Run! We must inform the other Ascendants!"

The Ascendants before me had relied solely on their own power, crushing only weaker opponents. That was why they were dying now. Their history had become their weakness.

"Two."

「 Baekcheong-Ganggi, overlaid with Way of the Wind, decapitated another ascendant.」

As the two incarnations crumbled in vain, the constellation's terrifying scream echoed through the air.

[The constellation, 'Horse-Possessing Twins', suffer a massive blow and are removed from the scenario!]

Interestingly, the recorders who recorded them are in a similar situation.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Writes Youth', loses his records and enters a period of inactivity.]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Doesn't Like Twists', loses his records and enters a period of inactivity.]

It seems the Recorders of Fear who signed a 'Recording Contract' take a major blow when the contracted incarnation dies.

So that's why Bihyung said I only need to deal with the contracted incarnation.

In any case, this leaves only one thing.

I turned my head to see a terrified Yoon Hyunseok preparing to flee.

Normally, he would have thrown a tantrum, having been cornered.

[The constellation, 'Unchanging One', lowers the synchronisation with the incarnation.]

Unfortunately, the guy's sponsor seemed to have made an unusual choice.

"Spo-Sponsor?"

Feeling his own status rapidly diminishing, Executive Director Yoon Hyunseok wore a blank expression.

"Hey, wait. Don't come! I told you not to come!"

If he were to lower his synchronisation with the incarnation in this situation, his purpose was clear.

Since this was a losing battle anyway, he'd probably lower his synchronisation to lessen the damage to his true form.

But I couldn't just let him run away. I pulled the 'Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword' from my pocket.

[The S+grade item 'Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword' evolves into the holy relic 'Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword.']

Originally, it could only be used with the power of the Big Dipper, but at the level of a Narrative-grade Constellation, it could be replaced with one's own Constellation.

My stories were imbued into the hilt of the 'Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword', and a bright starlight was engraved on its blade.

[The constellation, 'Unchanging One', looks at you in astonishment!]

[The constellation, 'Unchanging One', implores you. If you do not kill its incarnation-]

Swinging the 'Four Yin Demonic Beheading Sword', it slashed at its chest.

Immediately, a horrifying scream and the Constellation's message were heard.

[The Constellation, 'Unchanging One', suffered a massive blow and was forced out of the scenario!]

Leaving Yoon Hyunseok behind, who had collapsed to the ground, spilling his stories, I retrieved the D-Coins dropped by the dead executives.

[You have acquired a total of 25,300 D-Coins.]

As expected of an Executive, he had quite a lot of D-Coins.

At this rate, I should be able to collect 100,000 D-Coins in no time.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name' is retrieving the stories you borrowed.]

Just then, the time limit for 'Demon King of Salvation' mode expired. I tasted blood on my tongue. I forced myself to remain calm and swallowed my breath.

A faint spark coursed through my body.

I guess five stories is still too much.

"Benefactor, are you alright?"

"Inho-ssi—!"

I saw Namgung Myung and Kyung Sein, who had retreated for a moment, approaching.

I held out my palm to them, signaling them not to move.

Yoon Hyunseok's lifeline was still attached.

"Keuk..."

Even though he couldn't use the power of his sponsor, I couldn't let my guard down forever.

I approached him, maintaining [Baekcheong-ganggi].

"S-Spare me, spare me… "

I looked down at him and said,

"I have some questions for your 'Recorder'."

When I mentioned the Recorder's existence, Yoon Hyunseok's body trembled as if struck by lightning.

[The Recorder of Fear, the 'Unchanging One', is staring at you!]

Then, as if waiting, a message flashed through my mind.

[The Recorder of Fear, the 'Unchanging One', expects your generosity!]

There was a reason I kept him alive in the first place. There was information I needed to uncover.

What on earth are so many Recorders plotting in this city?

What are the Dokkaebis thinking hiring these guys?

Perhaps this 'Recorder' before me knows all that information.

"What do I get if I spare you?"

[The Recorder of Fear, the 'Unchanging One', offers D-Coins!]

"That's not necessary."

Considering what happened to my Eldest Brother, I had no intention of letting any of them live.

Still, I finally got the information. I couldn't miss this opportunity to rip it out.

But the next moment, instead of his answer, I heard his inner thoughts.

「Just a little more time.」

Huh?

「It'll be 'that time' soon. If we take refuge in the 'Records Archive' before we lose the contract, we can avoid the end of writing...!」

Records Archive?

Sensing something odd, I was about to swing my sword at Yoon Hyunseok's arm when...

「Hahahaha! That's it! It's two o'clock!」

A bright light emanated from Yoon Hyunseok's entire body, and soon a translucent energy surged through him.

The next moment, what looked like a pen mark the guy had left rippled through the air. I reached out and firmly grasped it, and a message flashed before my eyes.

[Would you like to enter the 'Records Archive' in that area?]

Seeing the message, something occurred to me.

「"Hmm. I heard there's a separate space only the recorders can access..."」

It seems I've finally figured out where the 'subspace' Bihyung spoke of was.

---

A pure white, circular space reminiscent of a gigantic Colosseum. Fierce sentences were floating in real time above the space's margins.

「Blood Jade Fist Master Jo Jincheol shouted, "Damn it, Mad Sword Emperor! I won't miss this time!"」

「Paradise Emperor Reinheit gritted his teeth. "As expected, Mad Sword Emperor. she truly lives up toher reputation."」

「Nirvana, filled with madness, shouted, "Hahahaha! Where did you go!? Become one with me!"」

As various incidents unfolded in the city, a dozen or so recorders scribbled on the screens, examining each one.

「...Auction house unusual report...」

「...High-level fragment analysis. Currently assessing probability...」

What was unusual was that each recorder wore a mask. Most were blue or purple, but occasionally green and orange masks were seen.

The recorder wearing the orange mask spoke first.

【What happened to the order from the Nebula? Has there been any change?】

The green mask beside him answered.

【It's the same. I've protested several times, but they say the decision won't be reversed. The city will be closed in the next scenario.】

【Is that how it's going to end?】

The orange mask spoke in a dejected tone. The city's scenery was reflected in his eyes behind his mask.

「New Murim District.」

Until now, this city has been divided into two parts, the remnants of the fallen Fear Realm. Its lifespan was sustained by the power of the three.

The fragments of the Fear Realm that were occasionally unearthed were refined into 'D-Coins', and these 'D-Coins' were transmitted to the constellations in the higher scenarios, proving their worth.

However, the vitality of such a system was limited.

【If only the Mad Sword Emperor hadn't destroyed the Orbital Elevator...】

When the orbital elevator was destroyed, the D-Coin circulation route was blocked, and naturally, the Ascendants who had become stronger through D-Coins also found their path to ascending blocked.

A single incarnation brought the entire city's system to its knees.

【In fact, this was expected even without the Mad Sword Emperor. The story fragments found in the Fear Realm were practically nonexistent.】

The Mad Sword Emperor was merely a trigger. Perhaps the constellations in the higher scenarios simply concluded that the city had outlived its usefulness.

【That's true. Wasn't there a harvest worth using this week?】

【There was talk of an 'End-level fragment' being discovered during the day...】

【End-level fragment?】

【Yes. The situation was so absurd that the new recruits stepped in and altered the records. The 'Management Bureau' is also investigating the probability of the scale.】

【End-level fragment...】

【If that's true, the Giant Nebulae above might have changed their minds.】

The orange mask, who had been thinking so, shook his head.

【There's no way there's an End-level fragment of Fear.】

【If there were still such fragments, the 'Twelve Thrones' of <Olympus> and the 'Locapala' of <Vedas> would have already descended, turning the city upside down.】

【When is the next scenario launch?】

【It's in an hour.】

【The Mad Sword Emperor? Or are we just going to leave her alone?】

【A small [Fate] launch order will soon be issued from the 'Giant Nebulae'.】

「Fate.」

At that statement, the recorders in the room whispered.

【You're using [Fate] to deal with just one incarnation?】

【It's not just one incarnation. We've deployed Ascendants, but we still haven't caught him. It's an incarnation with combat power greater than that of a Narrative-grade heavy machine.】

The orange mask, listening to the recorders' conversation, asked.

【Where was he last seen?】

【Near <Tamra Heavy Industry>.】

【Then the objective is clear.】

The orange mask stared at the <Tamra Heavy Industry> headquarters on the screen.

In the basement of that company, a monster once sealed by the recorders was imprisoned.

The orange mask smiled faintly, as if thinking about something.

【Since it's come to this, let's create a proper finale. A scenario of this scale will surely interest even the 'high-ranking Recorders'.】

The objective of every 'Recorder of Fear' is clear. It was about completing the 'ultimate sentence' to be left on the 'Final Wall'.

However, not all Recorders were able to achieve this ultimate sentence. Only the chosen recorders left behind great records.

Therefore, most recorders wanted to write 'commentaries' to accompany such a 'great sentence'.

【Listen carefully, everyone. If we successfully complete this scenario, we might even be able to claim the 'commentary' position from the high-ranking Recorders who monopolize the interpretation of the wall.】

【Re-Really?】

【Yes.】

The Recorders' eyes were filled with fear and excitement. It was understandable, before them, were the 'high-ranking recorders' of the <Star Stream>, beings they couldn't even dare to listen to, let alone look at—even their true names.

But what if they could help these high-ranking Recorders complete the 'One Sentence'...?

Just then, one of the recorders, who had been scanning the screen, ran over.

【Urgent news. Two recorders just stopped writing.】

Stopped writing. The weight of these words made all the Recorders' expressions harden for a moment. For the Recorders, the 'stop writing' was a punishment akin to eternal destruction, in terms of constellations.

The orange mask asked.

【What kind of guys are they?】

【Newbies. They're called 'One Who Writes Youth' and 'One Who Doesn't Like Twists'.】

The orange mask's eyes narrowed.

No matter what they did in this city, it was unlikely to cause an incident worthy of 'stopping writing'.

【If there was a possibility, it would be if the embodiment of the 'Recording Contract' died.】

The orange mask spoke in a grave voice.

【Perhaps it was the work of that bastard, the Mad Sword Emperor.】

【The Mad Sword Emperor.】

The tense recorders exchanged glances.

【Dispatch ascenders to the nearby area. If the Mad Sword Emperor is discovered—】

The order was finally given.

【Prepare to declare [Fate] immediately.】

---

The 'Recorder of Fear' trembled before my eyes.

【Uh, how? How could this be happening?】

To put it simply, it was like this.

He moved to this 'Recording Center' as soon as it was two o'clock, and I followed him.

He was jubilant, thinking he'd escaped safely, but then he turned to me and looked as if he were about to faint.

Hurriedly, he collected his expression and began to speak.

【W-Wouldn't you be the same 'Recorder'? But how could the contract holder and the Recorder be the same person...?】

I stared at the 'Unchanging One'.

I expected him to have some impressive appearance since he was called a 'Recorder of Fear', but he was just a young man wearing glasses. Compared to 'Asmodeus' and 'Bichonhori' I'd met before, he felt like a mere idiot. My silence must have been what the guy was thinking, as he fell to the ground and cried out.

【Please save me! I will never touch your contract again! I will not come near you! I will not add a single conjunction or adverb to your presence!】

I watched him for a moment before opening my mouth.

But no sound came out. Is it impossible to speak audibly in this space? In that case…

【Do you speak like this?】

At that moment, the 'Unchanging One' heard my voice and opened his eyes wide.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 919 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (4)

【No…】

The 'Unchanging One' stared at me for a moment, as if in a daze.

【Why?】

【It's nothing.】

【Speak.】

The 'Unchanging One' glanced at me and began to speak.

【I'm saying this because the tone of your mantra is so good.】

【What?】

【T-That's what I mean. Usually, the tone of your mantra is influenced by the stories the recorder has written. So it's a bit strange. What stories have you recorded to give it such a tone...】

So, you're saying my voice is pleasant to hear?

Judging by the fact that he's offering such blatant praise, it seems he's quite desperate.

【I don't intend to spare you just for saying that.】

【T-That's not what I meant!】

The man bit his lip, then opened his mouth again, taking note of the situation.

【Are you perhaps a 'True Recorder'?】

【True Recorder?】

【This refers to cases where one becomes a 'Recorder' on one's own, without making a contract with the 'Hunchback'.】

According to Bihyung, there are two ways to become a Recorder.

One is to achieve the feat of a 'Recorder' on one's own.

The other is to become a Recorder through a contract with the 'Wenny Man'.

When I nodded, the 'Unchanging One' nodded in admiration.

【I see. I don't know how a True Recorder came to this city, but...】

When he heard that I was a 'True Recorder,' he rolled his eyes again, prostrating himself before me and shouting,

【Please hire me!】

It was a funny word.

He wasn't just asking me to be his subordinate, he was asking me to 'hire him'?

【I will be your 'Assistant Recorder'.】

【Assistant Recorder?】

【As you know, no matter how great a Recorder is, there's a limit to what they can accomplish alone. Especially if you're trying to use a powerful 'record'...】

I got what he was saying. Even just the previous fight was a testament to that.

The pressure felt different when facing one Recorder than when facing three at once.

Surely, the more numerous the Recorders are, the more powerful their coercive power can be.

【I know. That's probably why you granted me [Fate].】

The 'Unchanging One' took a deep breath.

【That... was really not my intention! I only interfered a little without even knowing who you were!】

【After all, you were involved in that [Fate], weren't you?】

The 'Unchanging One' responded hastily, perhaps sensing the murderous intent emanating from my body.

【I simply did as I was told. I've fallen short of the task of adding strength to the newly written [Fate], so I just added a little bit of penmanship to the final [Fate]...】

As if he realized the situation was getting worse as he continued, the Unchanging One banged his head and spoke.

【I-I was wrong! I committed a mortal sin! It will never happen again!】

【That's a truly sincere apology.】

【Those bastards! I'll tell you who all the bastards were involved in that fate!】

【Hmm.】

I pretended to ponder for a moment, looking down at him.

【I know you're lying. You were just wasting time, begging for you life, and then you ran off here.】

【This time, it's really not happening! How could I dare deceive the Recorder, whose penmanship is far superior to mine? There's nowhere to run now!】

I hadn't explicitly told him, but I'd been hearing his inner thoughts here and there.

「There aren't many opportunities to face a true Recorder.」

「I don't know what level of Recorder this person is, but he's skilled enough to easily take on at least three lower-level Recorders.」

「There's only one way to survive.」

As someone who's just become a 'Recorder', it would be convenient to have a guide.

【In that case, prove it by signing a 'Recording Contract'.】

【A Recording Contract?】

The guy's eyes widened, and he feigned indifference.

【I'm not an incarnation or a Constellation, so I can't sign a 'recording contract' with you...】

【I'm sure there are similar contracts among Recorders, too?】

The guy, who had been furtively licking his lips as if he knew that, cautiously confessed.

【If you're referring to the 'Recording Oath'...】

After a moment, the contents of the 'Recording Oath' flashed before my eyes.

| |
|---|
| The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', swears the following: |

As I was reading the oath, the man asked,

【Can I use 'Demon King of Salvation' as your modifier?】

Strictly speaking, the Demon King of Salvation was a modifier that no longer existed.

To be clear, I need to write my name here...

A pounding headache suddenly struck me. It was the kind that would come whenever I tried to recall my real name.

I bit my lip and thought for a moment.

【Write that you are making a contract with the owner of the story 'Demon King of Salvation'.】

The revised oath then came to mind.

First, the Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', swears to become the 'assistant recorder' of the owner of the story 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Second, the Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', will not record anything that would harm the owner of the story 'Demon King of Salvation'.

Third, the Recorder of Fear, the 'Unchanging One', swears the above oath on the 'Final Wall'.

Fourth, as long as the Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', does not violate the above oath, the owner of the story 'Demon King of Salvation' will not harm the 'Unchanging One's' contracted entity.

* This oath lasts for 10 years immediately following the oath.

The oath exudes a unique sense of spirituality. The sentences felt just like a 'scenario' orchestrated by the Management Bureau.

Perhaps these Recorders are also the ones narrating the contents of the Management Bureau's 'scenario'.

【But what does 10 years mean?】

【Well, I need at least some insurance...】

【I'm sure you're just going to be stuck in a Time Fault for 10 years, killing time.】

【No, absolutely not!】

* The contracted party cannot enter a 'Time Fault' and arbitrarily accelerate the contract time.

As the boy, though he'd been crying, finished writing the special terms, the oath was sealed in a bright ray of light.

[The Recording Oath is activated.]

[The Recorder of Fear, Unchanging One, has become your 'Assistant Recorder'.]

Indeed, my writing skills felt even more vivid than before. I can't quite put it into words, but it felt like I had a small, auxiliary battery.

At this point, I'd say the safety net was in place.

I slowly looked around the 'Recording Archives', asking.

【First of all... where is this place?】

Perhaps because he had become my 'Assistant Recorder', he answered with the energy of a new employee.

【Yes. This is the 'Recording Archives'. Each scenario area has a record archive, a place granted to the recorders of the 'New Murim District'.】

【What do you do here?】

【Recorders gather here to declare [Fate] and share their own 'interpretations'.】

So, to summarize, this is like a banquet hall for recorders.

【Actually, 'True Recorders' rarely use this space. I heard that 'True Recorders' exchange information in a special way related to the 'Final Wall'.】

A special way related to the 'Final Wall'...

【However, low-level Recorders like me have almost no 'interpretations', so if we want to share even a little, we have to use this place.】

The 'Unchanging One' pointed to the 'doors' lined up at the front of the waiting room.

【These are the so-called 'Rooms of Narrative'. When you enter, you can interact with other recorders, and sometimes even plot or interfere with [Fate] to change the scenario.】

The 'Unchanging One' spoke somewhat cautiously when speaking about [Fate].

【Oh, and you must wear a 'Mask' before entering. That's the rule.】

Actually, as I approached the 'Room of Narratives', a message appeared above me as if it had been waiting.

[Please select the 'Mask' you will use after entering.]

[The list of masks will be randomly selected based on the 'stories' you recorded.]

1. Fox Mask.

2. Wolf Mask.

3. Rat Mask.

4. Maskless Mask.

5. Dumpling Mask.

…

The 'Recycling Center' came to mind.

Back then, I chose the maskless mask. There are more options here... After much deliberation, I decided to go with a more ordinary choice this time.

[You chose the 'Fox Mask'.]

When I put on the mask, a ray of light shone through the mask surrounding my face, changing color.

But the expression on the face of the 'Unchanging One"s face as he examined my mask was strange.

【Why?】

【Usually, the color of a recorder's mask is determined by their rank, which is one of seven colors.】

According to his explanation, the color of the mask given was determined by one of the following: red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, and violet.

Higher rank recorders wore masks closer to red, while lower ranks wore masks closer to purple.

In reality, the 'Unchanging One' was wearing a 'Blue Hamster' mask.

This probably meant he was in the third lowest rank.

The problem was the color of my mask.

【But your mask—】

The 'Unchanging One' glared, as if searching for even the slightest trace of color in my mask.

【It's white.】

【Didn't you say the mask's color was red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, and violet?】

【I don't know. Are the 'True Recorders' somehow different? Actually, this is my first time seeing an 'True Recorder' myself.】

Are there fewer 'True Recorders' like me than I thought?

【However, it's quite interesting that you chose the fox mask.】

Interesting?

【I heard that the creator of this 'Record Archive' also wore a 'Fox Mask'.】

That was unexpected information.

This 'Record Archive' is a subspace that doesn't even appear in the original 'Ways of Survival'.

I wonder what being created this place.

【Who created this place?】

【The 'Record Archive' is a place created by the great Recorder, the 'Fox Who Commands the Heavens', out of consideration for the lowly, lower-level Recorders.】

【The Fox Who Commands the Sky? Are you talking about Bicheonhori?】

【Do you know him?】

【I do. Bicheonhori Wang Weilong.】

So far, I've encountered Bicheonhori three times.

The last time was probably in the Fear Realm.

【Is he also a 'True Recorder'?】

If you think about it carefully, it wasn't strange.

The '100 Strongest' he wrote was a famous work within the 'Ways of Survival'.

Since Bicheonhori had been so obsessed with 'recording' in every round of Yoo Joonghyuk's series, perhaps no one could be more deserving of the title of 'True Recorder'.

But...

【Hey.】

The 'Unchanging One' was acting a little strange. He looked at me with anxious eyes, hiding his trembling voice, and asked.

【Excuse me... Whose name is that...?】

【Wang Weilong?】

【Yes.】

【That's Bicheonhori's true name.】

【Bi-bi-Bicheon... The Fox That Commands The Sky... Is...?】

【Right.】

【Oooooh!】

I hurried over and shook the guy's shoulder, but he was so unconscious he showed no signs of waking up. Judging by the bloody tears leaking from his eyes, it didn't seem to be an act.

【Hey. I told you to get up?】

Sentences poured out ceaselessly from the guy's head.

「Thetruenameofthegreatrecorder,thetruenameofthegreatrecorder,thetruenameofthegreatrecorder,thetruenameofthegreatrecorder,thetruenameofthegreatrecorder,thetruenameofthegr

eatrecorder...」

...Is this all I've got to do after hearing the true name of 'Bicheonhori'?

I left the fallen guy alone and slowly stood up.

If this were true...

I had a new card to use in my dealings with the recorders.

[Would you like to enter the 'Room of Narration'?]

I checked the available rooms in the waiting room one by one.

The name of the largest room was as follows:

—Room of Fate [43/100]

This is likely the room where the [Fate] he spoke of is pronounced.

The number [43/100] likely refers to the total number of people in the room and the number of people who have entered.

I wish I could just enter, but unfortunately, a message popped up saying I had no access.

I looked around the other rooms, feeling disappointed.

Most were empty, but some were occupied.

—Main Scenario Agenda Exchange Meeting [3/10]

This was a major scenario agenda,

and judging by the number 3, there were three visitors. Interestingly, there were small hashtags posted next to the room.

# Transcendence

# Scenario 80

It seemed to be a place to exchange information about something like this.

# New Murim District

# Mad Sword Emperor

After checking the last hashtag, I pressed the enter button without hesitation.

# The Oldest Dream

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 920 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (5)

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[This room has an 'Entry Keyword'.]

I frowned at the unexpected message. I wondered if I could enter here either, but thankfully, there was a hint.

[Would you like to check the keyword 'hint'?]

I nodded, and the hint immediately came to me.

[Please answer the true name of the Recorder who created the great 'Record Archive'.]

The owner of the great Record Archive.

It couldn't have been anything other than an incredible coincidence.

【Wang Weilong.】

The moment I answered, a strange tension filled me.

Considering the room's entry requirements, there was a high possibility that there would be more useful information than I expected.

Because the 'Recorders' in this room were at least 'those who knew the true name of Bicheonhori'.

[In this 'Room of Narrative', the use of 'skills', 'stigmas', and 'storytelling' intended to harm others is restricted.]

Then, a warning message flashed before my eyes. Restricting [Skills], [Stigmas], and [Tales] that could harm one another meant prohibiting conflicts between the recorders within.

For me, it wasn't a particularly disadvantageous restriction.

[Entering the 'Room of Narration'.]

I blinked, and a sentence appeared on the pure white background.

「A Recorder is someone who shows off their butt to others.」

Written in a single stroke.

The moment I read the meaning embedded in the sentence, I realized. This was the legacy of Bicheonhori.

「Therefore, the key to becoming an excellent Recorder lies in two things: either create a pretty butt that anyone can see, or make your butt not look like a butt.」

It was a peculiar author's theory. If Giyeon hyung had been there, he would have nodded in agreement.

Indeed, the Recorder who wrote 『100 Strongest』 was different.

The background was brightly lit. In the clean room, chairs were lined up around a long table in the center. The chairs were all different shapes. Some looked like the chairs of company executives, while others resembled convenience store chairs. Some were more like benches than chairs.

I recalled a story associated with those chairs.

「The Meeting of the Seven Kings of Seoul.」

When the 'Seven Kings of Seoul' were chosen in the 'Meeting of the Kings', each king sat on that chair and discussed Seoul's future.

In essence, Bicheonhori had created this place based on that 'Meeting of the Kings'.

This, too, was an homage, if you will.

As expected, three dolls were sitting in the room.

【Then, let's begin the meeting... huh?】

The first to react was the Recorder wearing a yellow mask. He wore a peculiar mask, but more accurately, his entire face looked more like a symbol than a mask.

Is that... a 'scale'?

【A rare newcomer.】

Then, a soft voice spoke from an orange mask. It seemed to be a mask shaped like a mountain. Above the mountain, something like a cloud floated, and curiously, a beam of light streaming from the cloud seemed to engulf the mountain.

【...】

Finally, the owner of the red mask looked at me. The entire head of the mask resembled an old monitor. A mask that glowed red, like a screen—its ominous light sent a chill down my spine.

I took in the gazes of the three dolls and calmly examined their faces again.

Yellow scales.

Orange mountains.

Red monitors.

I could tell from their aura alone that these recorders were of a different class from the 'Unchanging One'.

Their masks were yellow, orange, and red, respectively. In other words, they belonged to the top three ranks of the seven tiers of 'red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, and violet'.

Even at first glance, the orange mountains and red monitors were particularly striking. Of course, it wasn't as overwhelming as when I faced Bicheonhori, Cheon Inho, and Asmodeus in the 40th Round...

【A white mask?】

【Was there a mask of that color?】

While the scales and the mountain muttered, I calmly walked over and sat down on a chair.

The chair I chose was transparent. A 'transparent chair' so transparent that you couldn't even tell if you were sitting or not.

As I chose the chair, the red monitor opened his mouth, seemingly intrigued.

【How did you get into this room?】

The tone of the question sounded like a broken television.

I calmly answered.

【I answered the question correctly.】

【Who told you that answer?】

It seems Bicheonhori's true name is a secret among the recorders.

I shrugged and said.

【Isn't this a place where information is traded? If you want to learn something from me, you'll have to pay a price.】

The yellow scale looked surprised at my response, while the orange mountain looked intrigued.

The red monitor replied in a cold voice.

【I have no intention of interacting with someone whose identity I don't even know.】

【Isn't it equally true that we don't know each other's identities? Seeing all of you wearing masks, it doesn't seem like we're here to have a deep conversation.】

The three Recorders flinched simultaneously at my answer.

I observed their reactions, then grinned and added.

【I will answer your first question for free. As for how I came to know the true name of Bicheonhori—】

Since we're not going to fight right now, there's no need to provoke undue hostility until I get the information.

So, I can answer this honestly and with a generous heart.

【I just knew it all along.】

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

[Lie Detection doesn't seem to be a particularly harmful skill, so it seems it can be used here as well.]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed your words.]

The three Recorders reacted differently to the confirmation message from [Lie Detection].

Yellow Scale shrugged, as if surprised again, while Orange Mountain crossed his arms, seeming even more intrigued.

And...

【You 'just' knew the true name of the owner of the archives? Are you expecting me to believe that now?】

Sparks flew across the red monitor's screen.

Orange Mountain quickly intervened.

【Stop it, Hermit. Since he answered the question and entered the room, we have no right to sanction him.】

Hermit. Is that the red monitor's nickname?

Orange Mountain turned to me this time and spoke.

【And White Fox, you came here to gather information, too, I suppose. I didn't mean to be territorial. Instead, I apologize.】

I think it was said that the Recorder's mantras were influenced by the stories they recorded.

The orange mountain's mantra had a strangely gentle tone, and the rhythm evoked a certain longing in me.

【Since you're a newcomer, why don't you introduce yourself? White Fox, you have a nickname, right?】

Nickname?

Before I could even ask, Yellow Scale, with his shoulders hunched, spoke.

【You can call me 'Moral'.】

The yellow scale, with its strangely ominous, submissive demeanor—'Moral'.

I thought for a moment, listening to his mantra.

Unlike the 'Unchanging One', the three Recorders before me were somewhat higher-ranking beings. Perhaps, like Bicheonhori and Asmodeus, they too were characters from 'Ways of Survival'. Next, the nickname was revealed: 'Orange Mountain'.

【Please call me 'Cloud Mountain.'】

The orange mountain with its clear and gentle mantra—'Cloud Mountain'.

It was an intuitive nickname that suited the mask well.

I tried to think of characters related to 'mountain' or 'cloud', but there were so many of them in 'Ways of Survival', it was difficult to deduce their identities.

【'Hermit'.】

Finally, the red monitor—'Hermit'.

One character immediately came to mind when I heard the keyword 'Hermit'.

But I didn't have time to think deeply about it. It was my turn to answer.

【A nickname. I can just make up anything, right?】

I was thinking something like 'Friend of the Dirt-Eater' or 'Disciple of the Transcendently Beautiful Girl Author' would work, but Hermit spoke with sparks flying.

【What nonsense are you talking about? Didn't you read the entrance notice when you came in?】

【Entrance notice?】

【Here, you must choose a nickname that has even a slight connection to your 'story'.】

The moment I heard Cloud Mountain's comment, I had a realization.

「Either you create a really pretty butt that you don't mind showing off to anyone, or you make your butt not look like a butt.」

I see. Was that what this room's entrance notice meant?

In short, the 'nicknames' here were a kind of game devised by Bicheonhori. A 'game' where you reveal important clues about yourself to guess others' identities.

So, I had to choose a nickname that was related to me while ensuring my identity would never be revealed.

【My nickname is...】

Come to think of it, there was one nickname that would be appropriate at this point.

【'Kim Dokja'.】

Eight years after the fall of the Fear Realm. Even eight years ago, stories about the 'Kim Dokja fragments' were spreading, and recalling my conversations with Cho Jincheol and Reinheit, the name 'Kim Dokja' felt quite commonplace.

「"You think you're 'Kim Dokja' yourself?"」

It was highly likely that there were others pretending to be 'Kim Dokja' while I was gone.

In that sense, the name 'Kim Dokja' was the perfect 'butt' to reveal my identity while simultaneously concealing it perfectly.

【Hmph...?】

Someone groaned, perhaps startled by my butt.

【What did you just say?】

【'Kim Dokja'.】

Actually, I chose the nickname 'Kim Dokja' not simply to hide my identity.

「Kim Dokja is the true name of the 'Oldest Dream'.」

According to the setting of 'Ways of Survival', the 'true names' of all high-level beings in the <Star Stream> are restricted.

Especially, those of lower ranks can sometimes suffer a severe blow simply by mentioning the true name of a higher-level being. This was likely the reason why the 'Unchanging One' fainted upon learning the true name of 'Bicheonhori'.

However, the name 'Kim Dokja' alone never inflicted damage upon the speaker.

Common sense dictates that no constellation exists higher than the 'Oldest Dream', so anyone who invoked its name should have suffered a blow close to annihilation.

However, this has never occurred.

I have two hypotheses regarding this.

First, the name 'Kim Dokja' does not refer to a single being.

Second, the story surrounding 'Kim Dokja' and the 'Oldest Dream' is so distant that no one has ever been able to trace it.

Because they didn't quite understand.

But that was only for ordinary incarnations or Constellations who didn't know well. I wondered what it would be like for the recorders.

High-ranking Recorders like Bicheonhorin and Asmodeus could call out the name 'Kim Dokja' without hesitation, but what about the other recorders?

【Dare.】

With sparks flowing through the air, Hermit slammed the table in a fit of agitation.

A pale aura hovered above his monitor.

He seemed poised to attack me at any moment.

Of course, according to the room's rules, I wouldn't be attacked, so I stared at Hermit for a moment before looking around at the other recorders.

Moral looked dazed, as if he'd just experienced something unpleasant, and Cloud Mountain's reaction was difficult to discern.

Cloud Mountain spoke.

【Hermit, calm down. It's just a nickname.】

【...】

【You're an interesting person. Are you sure you want to use 'that name' as your nickname?】

【Yes. Is there anything that wouldn't work?】

【Of course not.】

Unlike Moral and Hermit, who seemed to be strangely averse to the nickname 'Kim Dokja', Cloud Mountain seemed even more interested in me after hearing my nickname.

【Now that we've finished our introductions, shall we share the keywords from the information we've shared?】

【How about we start with the newbie? Since we're only going to talk about keywords anyway, the order doesn't matter.】

At Moral's words, the three Recorders looked at me simultaneously.

They say that, but if they feel it would be detrimental to them after hearing the keywords, they won't engage in the exchange. When I refused to open my mouth, Cloud Mountain chimed in.

【If it's inconvenient, I can speak first. I could demonstrate, too.】

【Would you mind?】

I was grateful.

There was plenty of information to use as a bargaining chip, but before that, I needed to figure out how much they knew and what they wanted.

【The information I brought...】

For a moment, I felt the mask on the cloud mountain smile.

【It's about the disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint—the 'Mad Sword Emperor'.】

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# 921 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (6)

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A disciple of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

There's only one person in this world who truly fits that nickname.

「Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk.」

I, too, thought of him when I first discovered traces of the Mad Sword Emperor in the examination hall.

The question is this:

「Is Yoo Joonghyuk really the Mad Sword Emperor?」

If the Mad Sword Emperor is truly Yoo Joonghyuk, it's absurd that Nirvana didn't recognize him.

Furthermore, there's further evidence that the Mad Sword Emperor isn't Yoo Joonghyuk.

「Yoo Joonghyuk's primary weapon in the 41st Round was a 'spear'.」

What I discovered in the examination hall was clearly a 'sword mark'.

Unless Yoo Joonghyuk, who had suddenly transformed into the Breaking the Sky Sword Beauty, had once again wielded a sword.

Of course, that possibility is impossible, so common sense dictates that the 'Mad Sword Emperor' Cloud Mountain speaks of is not Yoo Joonghyuk, but someone else.

【Breaking the Sky Sword Saint... You're talking about the Transcendent imprisoned in the underworld of Murim. Was the Mad Sword Emperor her disciple?】

I froze for a moment.

Who is imprisoned where?

【Yes, that's my guess.】

Watching Cloud Mountain silently nod, I forced myself to take a deep breath. I wanted to ask about the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint right away, but I had to hold back.

The last time I saw the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was eight years ago. I even heard that she had come to Murim with the 'Mad Sword Emperor'.

But she was imprisoned?

Who could dare imprison her?

The Ascendants? Of course, all the Ascendants in this city were strong. There were many who were comparable to the Narrative-level.

But even within the same 'Narrative-level', the difference in rank was vast. The Breaking the Sky Sword Saint wasn't just high-level; her fighting prowess was extraordinary.

No wonder she was called the 'god' of Murim. But she was imprisoned in Murim.

How on earth? Could she possibly be connected to the 'Mad Sword Emperor'?

Feeling compelled to find out, I cautiously opened my mouth, but Hermit spoke in a disgruntled tone.

【Do you think I came all the way here just to hear something like that?】

「I desperately want to hear this information, so I want to tell you to shut up.」

Thankfully, Cloud Mountain didn't back down and responded.

【That's all I need. Do you think your master feels the same way?】

...Master?

It was a bit surprising. Hermit, the 'Red Mask', didn't seem like the type of person who would claim to be someone's subordinate.

【He's not just another incarnation, but a disciple of the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'. If you're a Recorder, you'd know who Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's disciples are. Your master would be quite interested in this story, right? Because—】

Hermit, momentarily showing discomfort, quickly cut Cloud Mountain off.

【So, who is the Mad Sword Emperor?】

【Are you interested?】

【Tell me, Cloud Mountain.】

【No one knows her true identity because she always wears a skull mask. She appeared like a comet eight years ago with the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, and is known as the 'Mad Sword Emperor'. Her main area of aIctivity is the 'New Murim District'.】

【You could even ask a low-level Recorder about that.】

【I'm not finished telling you yet. You heard about the recent destruction of the Orbital Elevator in the 'New Murim District', right?】

【Was it really the Mad Sword Emperor who destroyed it?】

I knew that story. I even witnessed it.

Judging by his expression, Hermit didn't seem to know that much, and Moral... seemed to be half-associate.

Hermit asked.

【Why would she do something like that? Doing something like that would incur the wrath of the Giant Nebulae.】

I was curious, too. Regardless of the identity of the Mad Sword Emperor, the 'Orbital Elevator' served as a crucial bridge for the Ascendants and the higher-level Nebulae.

But destroying it meant...

【The Mad Sword Emperor realized the purpose of the 'New Murim District' city.】

At those words, Hermit and Moral fell silent simultaneously. A cold agitation rippled through the table, and then—

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

[The statement has been confirmed to be true.]

Hermit glared at Cloud Mountain and asked,

【How on earth did you know such information? Did you sign a 'Recording Contract' with the Mad Sword Emperor?】

【If you want to hear more, please disclose the information. I heard you brought something quite interesting today, didn't you?】

【...】

【You won't be the only one to receive the information like last time, will you? This time, there will be a 'penalty'.】

Hermit flared at the mention of the penalty.

【The information I bring is on a different level than yours.】

【Of course you would. You follow the great 'High-Rank Recorder'.】

A high-ranking Recorder...

So, does that mean 'Hermit' follows high-ranking Recorders like Bicheonhori or Cheon Inho?

Sensing my gaze, Hermit glanced in my direction and muttered smugly.

【You're lucky.】

I thought it was just a whisper, but Hermit continued, tapping the table like a keyboard.

【The information I brought is about the 'Large Fragment of the Oldest Dream'.】

It was a boastful piece of information.

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

[The statement has been confirmed to be true.]

Cloud Mountain and Moral, having confirmed the truth, exchanged a glance and asked.

【This is quite interesting.】

【If it's a large fragment, how big is it?】

【It could possibly be comparable to the King of Fear.】

For a moment, I thought he was talking about me. At this point, there must be only a handful of 'Kim Dokja fragments' that large.

A bright light shone from the mask of Cloud Mountain.

【Interesting. So? Tell me more. What kind of fragment is it?】

【It's a newly discovered fragment. It's clearly different from the ones known so far.】

【Have the other Nebulae noticed? Where was it found? Could it be—】

【That's it. I'll listen to your information and tell you the rest.】

【Hmm…】

Cloud Mountain seemed displeased, but didn't seem to want to press on.

Now that it was certain that it was information about the 'Oldest Dream', the information from the Hermit proved worth listening to to the end.

Finally, the two men's gazes turned to me and Moral.

I tossed their gazes back at Moral.

Moral stared at me with a bewildered expression for a moment, then flinched uncomfortably and opened his mouth.

【Well... As a senior, I suppose it wouldn't be a bad idea for me to speak first.】

He continued with his characteristically gloomy tone.

【I've brought quite a bit. If any of this interests you, I'll tell you in detail...】

【I didn't expect much anyway. I guess you're just going to brush it off with some worthless garbage.】

Undeterred by Hermit's cynicism, Moral began to speak.

【Just listen.】

The first piece of information he brought was about the upper scenario area.

【'Ragnarok' will begin soon.】

Ragnarok.

Along with <Eden>'s 'Great War of Good and Evil' and <Olympus>'s 'Gigantomachia', the 'Great Destruction Scenario' that represents the Star Stream was finally about to begin. It was quite useful information, so I nodded meaningfully to Moral in interest.

But the other two Recorders seemed to have different thoughts.

【We already know that. Is there anything else?】

【Yes.】

The second piece of information Moral brought was that the boundaries of the worldline were gradually collapsing after the destruction of the Fear Realm.

But this information didn't seem new to the other two Recorders.

【As expected, you're just making a fuss again today, are you?】

【Actually, I've done some research on the Mad Sword Emperor, but honestly, I don't know as much as you, Cloud Mountain.】

【So, what else?】

【There's been a recent discord within <Olympus>.】

The discord within <Olympus>.

Is that the beginning of that in this episode?

【The 'God of Wine and Ecstasy' has declared independence from <Olympus> with his forces.】

Dionysus's independence. This was quite interesting information, so I nodded meaningfully at him again.

Moral, emboldened by my response, was about to speak again when...

【That must have been information from months ago.】

The cold retort of Hermit cut him off.

【Are you offering to exchange information on the 'Oldest Dream' for information on something even a low-level Recorder would know?】

【That's—】

【If this keeps up, I'll remove Moral from the team next time.】

Cloud Mountain nodded in agreement.

【I'm a bit disappointed this time. Since we have a new member, it's time to change the members.】

【Now, wait a minute. It's not over yet.】

I felt like I had a rough idea of the Recorders' positions in this room.

Cornered, Moral sweated profusely and spoke again.

【This is somewhat ambiguous information, so I hesitated to share it.】

【Ambiguous information?】

【An appraisal item that has reached the highest 'Appraisal Ranking' has appeared in the auction house of the 'New Murim District'.】

【What kind of appraisal item is it?】

【It's a 'fragment of the End-level Fear'.】

A silence fell over the table for a moment. Hermit was the first to speak.

【This is the first time I've been surprised by the information you brought.】

【Are you sure it's the End-level Fear?】

The two Recorders looked genuinely astonished.

Of course, I was equally astonished.

Because that was my story.

【Has this already reached that level?】

【Perhaps 'Moral's' sphere of activity is within my vicinity.】

【The results of the 'scales' appraisal are correct, but they're not yet conclusive. The Management Bureau has determined that it's 'probable'.】

Hermit seemed to lose interest at the mention of 'probable'. But Cloud Mountain was different.

【Who brought that?】

Is it a mistake? A strange sense of impatience was palpable from Cloud Mountain, who had always been so relaxed.

【Could it be someone from the Fear Realm? A Transcendent, perhaps—】

【That's possible, but I don't think so.】

【Why?】

【According to eyewitness accounts, he was just an ordinary incarnation. His rank wasn't high either.】

【What did he look like? What color was his hair? What clothes was he wearing?】

Cloud Mountain's persistent questions almost seemed obsessive.

Hermit spoke in a hushed tone.

【Cloud mountain, it seems it was true that you were looking for a Transcendent from the Fear Realm.】

【...】

【There hasn't been a returnee from the Fear Realm since 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'. You should know that.】

It seems that's all the information known to the public. Looking at the situation, the 'Recorders of Fear' outside seemed to be unaware of the exact events that occurred inside the Fear Realm.

Cloud Mountain happened to be searching for someone inside.

I was at a loss as to what information to reveal, but I thought it was a good thing.

【It seems like everyone else doesn't know, but there's another Returnee of the Fear Realm.】

At my words, the three recorders turned to me simultaneously.

【What nonsense are you talking about? How do you know that?】

【I saw it myself.】

【What?】

【The destruction of the Fear Realm.】

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that what you said is true.]

The message rang out, as if it had been waiting for it.

【That can't be. You saw it? How?】

With a quiet shock, Cloud Mountain asked in a dazed voice.

【How could you see what happened inside?】

【Did you sign a 'Recording Contract' with a transcendent?】

Faced with a barrage of questions, I feigned a smile and answered.

【Such personal questions are difficult.】

If I'm not careful, my 'butt' could be exposed.

【If you're trying to avoid it with that kind of talk—】

【You all know that there were 'high-ranking Recorders' there, right?】

The three Recorders nodded, glancing at each other.

So, everyone knew this much?

【I met the 'Fox that Commands the Sky' there.】

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed that what you said is true.]

Cloud Mountain was dazed, what he was thinking unknown, while Moral looked somewhat agitated.

【Did you really see Bicheonhori yourself?】

Even Hermit, who had always been sarcastic and scornful of others' information, couldn't hide his emotions.

【Tell me. What exactly happened there? What on earth did you see?】

In an instant, the control of the situation shifted to this side.

【Do you think you're qualified to hear that with the information you've brought?】

A heavy silence fell over the table. A silence where anger, curiosity, and shock strangely coexisted. As if enjoying the silence, I opened my mouth.

【Let's do this. Tell me what I'm curious about first.】

【What do you want to know?】

【The exact time of Ragnarok's outbreak. The current status of the Mad Sword Emperor. And the spatiotemporal coordinates of the large fragment of the Oldest Dream.】

The three Recorders looked at each other and nodded.

【If we tell you that, what exactly will you tell us?】

【I'll give you a choice, so choose for yourself.】

【Choices?】

For reference, the choices I presented were:

**<Top Secret List of the Fear Realm>**

1. The story of 'Kim Anna', the great Catastrophe-level Fear.

2. Additional information on survivors of the 'Fear Realm'.

3. The secret of the 'Oldest Dream', which Recorder 'Bicheonhori' was curious about.

The Recorders glared at the choices I offered with serious eyes.

Moral was the first to speak.

【Are you really going to tell me this? Do I just have to choose one of the three?】

【Yes. I'll tell you privately whichever one you choose.】

I smiled and whispered meaningfully.

【For your information, one of the three is a trap.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 922 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (7)

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As expected, Hermit was the first to react.

【One of the three is a trap? What do you mean?】

【Exactly.】

Sullen red eyes floated over Hermit's monitor.

【You're ridiculous. Do you think I'd make a deal like this?】

【If you don't like it, then don't.】

【What?】

【Honestly, I don't care if I don't listen to your information.】

The information Hermit had was about the 'Large Fragment of the Oldest Dream'. It was information I was curious about, but in a way, it wasn't information I 'needed to hear immediately'.

He was furious, perhaps hurt by the fact that his information was so daringly judged.

【Do you think you'll get away with something like this? You don't think I'll find out who you are? As soon as I leave this room, I'll find your contract partner and...】

【Yes, yes. You seem curious about my butt. Look carefully.】

Moral chuckled at my words.

I turned to Moral and Cloud Mountain and asked.

【What will the other two do?】

【I'll make a deal.】

Cloud Mountain was the first to answer.

Since Cloud Mountain is looking for the 'Returnee of the Fear Realm', I thought they'd naturally agree to my deal.

【I will do it.】

Moral also accepted the deal.

Perhaps it was only natural.

The information he possessed regarding the 'time of Ragnarok's occurrence' wasn't very valuable at this point, and its value would soon expire.

【Then let's just make a deal between you two...】

【Wait. I'll make a deal too.】

【You said you wouldn't?】

Hermit answered after two seconds.

【I've changed my mind.】

【I've changed my mind too. I won't make a deal with you. You threatened me.】

【That—】

A silence that seemed a mixture of bewilderment and anger. After a moment of hesitation, Hermit opened his mouth.

【That was a slip of the tongue. I apologize.】

As expected, even the most proud 'Recorder of Fear' is a Recorder. He wouldn't miss an opportunity to gain an interpretation of the 'Fear Realm'.

Moral and Cloud Mountain, who had been watching our conversation from the side, murmured in admiration.

【Just words?】

A disgruntled emoticon appeared on Hermit's monitor.

【Then?】

【Besides the spatiotemporal coordinates of the 'Large Fragment of the Oldest Dream', you need to give me one more piece of information.】

【Didn't you say that was enough earlier?】

【Shouldn't we make a deal?】

A sound like a monitor component breaking came from somewhere, and Hermit asked.

【What information do you want?】

【You said something interesting when you were talking to Cloud Mountain. You said the Mad Sword Emperor had figured out the purpose of the city called 'New Murim District'.】

【So?】

【I'd also like to hear the purpose of the city called 'New Murim District'.】

Hermit hesitated for a moment before answering.

【You're a peculiar fellow. If you know about the 'Fear Realm', you must be a Recorder of a higher-level scenario, but you don't know that information.】

I felt a pang of disappointment, but I shamelessly shrugged my shoulders.

【I wasn't particularly interested in that area.】

【Understood. Then let's make a deal by telling you those two pieces of information. However, I'll go first among the three of us. You don't mind, do you?】

【As long as everyone else is okay with it.】

The other Recorders didn't seem to want to clash with Hermit, so they didn't particularly complain about the order.

While Hermit carefully considered his options, Moral asked,

【Hermit, which one will you choose? He told us there's a trap, didn't he?】

【It's obvious. Number 1 is a trap.】

The 'number 1' they were talking about was 'the adventures of the great Disaster-level Fear: Kim Anna'.

Moral objected.

【Doesn't number 1 seem too blatantly like a trap?】

【If that guy isn't an idiot, he'd obviously have us twist our minds several times to make us choose.】

【So you're saying he's twisting our minds to make us choose number 1 instead?】

I nodded, listening to their logic with fascination.

【Have you chosen?】

【I'll listen to number 3.】

Number 3.

You made a good choice.

【Good. Then, please give me your information first.】

Something printed on the secluded monitor, and a small hologram document appeared before me.

I furrowed my brow and began reading.

There are three 'Large Fragments of the Oldest Dream' identified so far.

1. Object name: 'Demon King of Salvation'. A fragment that went missing with the closing of the 'Recycling Center'. It likely belonged to the incarnation that battled it at the 'Recycling Center'.

…

Honestly, I was surprised by the information, which was more valuable than I expected.

This document served as a sort of indicator of how much the 'Recorders of Fear', including the 'Unchanging One', understood about the 'Oldest Dream'.

2. Object Name: 'King of Fear'.

A fragment torn off when the 'Fear Realm' met its end. It's believed that some of it was absorbed by ■■■■■■ at that time.

…

Is this how they know about the King of Fear?

Perhaps that ■■■■■■ represents Asmodeus.

I continued reading the document.

3. ■■■.

Unfortunately, the information on the third fragment was filtered. This likely means that even the Recorder in front of me doesn't have a proper understanding of it. The story didn't end there.

In addition, the location of the 'Fourth Large Fragment' was observed.

The Fourth Fragment.

Finally, this was the information I was looking for.

> At this point, it's determined that the Fragment in question does not exist within that worldline.

I read and reread that passage with blank eyes.

I knew it instinctively.

This was a clue to the 'Third Kim Dokja'. These damned bastards had discovered the location of the 'Third Kim Dokja' before I did.

> The spatiotemporal coordinates of the fragment in question could not be precisely determined.
>
> However, the 'context of certain Constellations' was observed. The keywords extracted from the context were as follows:
>
> Emperor. Monkey. Sword and Shield.

Emperor? Monkey? Sword and Shield?

I mulled over the keywords several times before asking,

【Is this the answer? I thought you meant 'spatiotemporal coordinates'.】

【I didn't understand that far. However, we can make some inferences with the keywords attached. This should be valuable information, right?】

Listening to the Hermit's bittersweet laughter, I wanted to smack him in the back of the head.

【Please send me other information, too.】

【Just sent it.】

The second piece of information I requested from Hermit was about the 'purpose of the creation of the New Murim District'.

I quickly skimmed through the second document and licked my lips.

I see. I expected it, but that's really how this city was created.

【Confirmed. Now, I'll give you the information. You said you'd choose the third option, correct?】

The Hermit's third option was 'the secret of the 'Oldest Dream' that the Recorder 'Bicheonhori' was curious about'.

I wrote a sentence in the air and sent it to him.

「The secret of the 'Oldest Dream' that Bicheonhori was curious about is...」

As I wrote the sentence, old memories flooded back. That day, I had shared a secret at the inn in Bicheonhori.

「It’s about 'the food the Oldest Dream hates the most'.」

The Hermit’s head throbbed as he read the sentence.

【What is this…】

I could feel his emotions fluctuating in real time. Confusion, shock, and…

【That… what kind of food is it?】

Curiosity. The excited boy’s words were slowly intensifying.

【Tell me. What kind of story is that?】

【It’s not a story, it’s food.】

【What?】

Since there seemed to be some misunderstanding, I thought it was a good thing and wrote the next sentence for him.

「The food the Oldest Dream hates the most is 'tomatoes'.」

The Hermit remained silent for a long time after reading the sentence. He seemed to be analyzing my sentence, or perhaps ruminating and savoring it. Or perhaps he didn’t understand it at all.

Moral, watching from the side, asked,

【Hermit, what information did you receive?】

Instead of answering, Hermit trembled convulsively and suddenly began emitting a wave of energy toward me.

【Are you trying to deceive me?】

【I expected you to get angry. But I only gave you a choice; you were the one who chose.】

【This doesn't make sense. This can't be all—】

【This is the whole story.】

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed your words.]

【There's no way! The 'Oldest Dream' is nothing more than that. The great 'Bicheonhori' couldn't possibly be curious about such information—】

【This is all.】

【Explain properly. What does tomato mean? What interpretation did Bicheonhori obtain?】

Since he seemed to be having trouble understanding me, I decided to be a little more friendly.

「Now, I'll explain briefly, so listen carefully. You know the prototype of the 'Oldest Dream' is Kim Dokja, right? Kim Dokja of Planet 8612, who has mastered the 'Ways of Survival'. This isn't a metaphor, it's just a fact. Tomatoes are a food Kim Dokja hates. Tomatoes! Literally, tomatoes!」

And then something strange happened.

「■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■...」

All the messages I had sent began to be filtered.

【Gasp.】

I heard a pop, and then I saw something flowing out of Hermit's head. Something like bloody juice was dripping onto the floor.

【You... What on earth did you send me?】

Hermit's body, who had been glaring at me as if he couldn't understand, dispersed. It was unexpected. Kim Dokja's name wasn't exactly a secret anymore, and I thought this level of information would be okay since even Bicheonhori and Asmodeus would share it without a second thought... or was I wrong?

As Hermit's figure vanished in an instant, Moral, who was standing nearby, exclaimed in admiration.

【Wow... That's surprising. Information that could force the expulsion of a red-ranked Hermit. That's extremely dangerous information.】

I felt there was some misunderstanding, but since it wasn't important, I didn't point it out.

【Cloud Mountain. May I take my turn next?】

【Please continue.】

Immediately, the information Moral had sent flashed before my eyes.

It was a brief description of the approximate timing of Ragnarok and the movements of the Great Gate.

It wasn't much information, but it was essential for me right now.

【Confirmed. Which option will you choose?】

【I'm also very curious about the third piece of information.】

【Then shall I tell you the third one?】

【No, I...】

Surprisingly, Moral chose the first option.

「The story of 'Kim Anna-ssi', Disaster-level Fear.」

Honestly, I never thought he'd choose that. Perhaps he was afraid that choosing the third option would lead to ending up like the Hermit.

I briefly relayed to Moral my interpretation of 'Anna Croft', whom I witnessed in the Fear Realm.

Kim Anna, who escaped from <Asgard> and chose to become a Transcendent.

Kim Anna, who nearly died from talking on the subway on her way home from work.

Kim Anna, who ran away in panic after encountering a Disaster-level Fear.

Kim Anna, who made me coffee...

As I recited the memories, a feeling of longing arose.

I wonder if Kim Anna is doing well.

【This is...】

Moral seemed to be reading the sentences I gave him with interest.

It made sense. Even though it was merely a series of disconnected memories, a mere record of observing a single incarnation—

【This is truly remarkable. You truly witnessed the 'Fear Realm'.】

At least this record clearly depicted the 'Fear Realm'.

【Honestly, I thought I'd picked a dud, but the interpretation you gave me seems far too extreme.】

Moral, who had been watching me for a moment, hesitated as if he had something to say. It was then that his form shook with a 'tsutsutsu' sound.

【Oh, I have a summons, so I must go.】

At that moment, a sentence flashed before his eyes.

「I don't know which scenario you're a Recorder for, but—」

The sentences continued above Moral, who slightly bowed his head.

「Whenever necessary, summon this 'Moral'. I'll help you.」

It was an unexpected favor. Contrary to his actions, perhaps he's more morally sound than I thought?

I nodded in gratitude.

The two quickly left, leaving only Cloud Mountain and I in the subspace.

Cloud Mountain, who had been watching me, spoke first.

【I've also been summoned. If it's alright, let's start the deal right away.】

Considering the group summons, something must have happened in their scenario.

【Understood.】

We immediately exchanged information.

The information he gave me was about the current status of the 'Mad Sword Emperor'. As I read it, I couldn't help but feel my face harden. If this was true, I needed to get out of here immediately.

Fortunately, Cloud Mountain also seemed to be in a hurry.

【I'll choose the second option.】

As expected, Cloud Mountain chose the second option.

| |
|---|
| Additional survivor information for the 'Fear Realm'. |

I wrote down the names of the survivors I remembered and sent them. It was a list of those who escaped aboard the 'train' on the day the Fear Realm ended.

Cloud Mountain read and reread the list for a long time, then asked,

【Is this all?】

【As far as I know, that's all there is to it. And the Fear Realm has ended.】

Because he was covered by a mask, I couldn't see Cloud Mountain's expression. However, judging by the slight downward tilt of his head, I could tell he was disappointed.

[NOTE 1]

【Should I go now?】

Cloud Mountain's body nodded, and slowly began to disperse from below.

When their body disappeared up to their knees, I asked,

【Cloud Mountain, what is the name of the being you seek?】

【Is it a deal?】

【You can think of it as you wish.】

Cloud Mountain looked at me for a moment before answering.

【It's a name I can't pronounce.】

【Why can't you pronounce it?】

【If I say that name, someone else will notice.】

I nodded silently.

Cloud Mountain, watching me, asked.

【I have a question, too.】

【Go ahead.】

Now, more than half of Cloud Mountain's body had vanished. Dispersing like a mountain collapsing, Cloud Mountain asked.

【What number was the 'trap'?】

The dispersing Cloud Mountain was looking at me. I, too, saw the Cloud Mountain.

The masks we wore were tagged with the story of 'recognition blocking', and because of that, we couldn't recognize each other. And yet.

【The trap.】

Even though eight years had passed between us.

【It was the second piece of information.】

Beyond Cloud Mountain's mask dissipating in the light, I thought I glimpsed their face. I thought I could see their eyes slowly dilating.

【Wait a minute, then—】

Perhaps this was just an elaborate optical illusion we created. We might have been endlessly repeating the name of the one we were seeking, in front of a completely different person. And yet, in that moment, in front of each other's masks, we reached a common interpretation.

【Auth...!】

With a ray of light, Cloud Mountain vanished.

I stared blankly down at the spot where they had vanished. I wanted to call their name right away.

Are they truly who I thought they were? If so, why, by what path did they become a 'Recorder of Fear', or why did they have to become so?

I couldn't ask. Perhaps because eight years lay before us, and—

【It seems you've enjoyed it enough. If you've seen it all, please leave.】

Because the one who knows those eight years is here with us now.

I glared into the air and said,

【Bicheonhori, Weilong】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: I used the pronoun 'he' by default for these recorders, but we don’t necessarily know their gender since they’re hiding their identities—and it was too confusing to individually call them ‘they’ when there were many in the room. Cloud Mountain could be a woman.

# 923 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (8)

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A light spark flickered in the air. A playful voice followed.

【Since when did you know?】

I felt a space opening, and a monster wearing a 'white fox mask' identical to mine appeared before my eyes.

Despite the 'perception blocking' effect, I could sense the intensity emanating from his entire body, and I was certain.

【Since you started playing pranks like the 'white fox mask'.】

Weilong, King of Bicheonhori.

The master who created this secret subspace was right before my eyes.

【Interesting. You already knew about it then?】

【Isn't it strange? I entered the space you created, and 'that mask' suddenly appeared as an option for me, as if it had been waiting for me.】

【So, do you like the mask I gave you?】

I looked at Bicheonhori, who was spinning. Perhaps because he was a high-ranking Recorder, he didn't produce any records like the other Recorders. That must mean he's in complete control of himself.

I decided to throw a rock, sending ripples through that serene mask.

【Since when have you been interfering with my [Fate]?】

Bicheonhori seemed to hesitate for a moment, then replied in a brazen voice.

【What are you talking about? Even I find it difficult to interfere with [Fate] without you noticing.】

That's right. If he had directly interfered with my [Fate], I couldn't have failed to notice the shift in the context surrounding me. However,

【If you were controlling the [Fate] of others, not mine, it would be a different story.】

What if the sentence he wrote wasn't about me?

From the 'Unchanging One' who heard Bicheonhori's true name to my entrance into this room—did all of those events truly rely on 'coincidence'? Instead of answering my question, Bicheonhori let out a light laugh, then added in a rather serious voice.

【Still, wasn't it a pleasant encounter thanks to me?】

I glared at him for a moment.

Perhaps even my encounter with Cloud Mountain here was recorded in his records.

【Is Cloud Mountain really who I think they are?】

【Is there any point in confirming that here?】

【Why did you lead me here?】

Of course, I was glad to meet him again, even briefly. But I also thought it shouldn't have ended this way.

【Is there any information you can extract from me? Are you still curious about the tomato story?】

【Really. I didn't bring you here for any particular evil purpose.】

A mysterious light began to flow from the eyes of the white fox mask.

【Now that you've become a 'Recorder', it's time you received your proper title.】

At the same time, a message rang out from the air.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Name Maker', grins.]

I flinched and looked around.

But there didn't seem to be any other Recorders of Fear besides Bicheonhori.

So, the name 'Name Maker' must be another modifier for Bicheonhori.

Thinking about it, it wasn't strange.

He was the author of the meditation-based work, 'The 100 Strongest'. He was the historian who personally gave countless characters nicknames.

【You're going to give me the modifier of a Recorder.】

【I see.】

【Do you give all the modifier for the new Recorders?】

【Most of them.】

Bicheonhori's mask grinned.

I quietly admired his smile and said.

【I have no intention of being confined by the 'context of modifiers' you created.】

The 'name' of everything in the <Star Stream> is imbued with a story. That story grows with its existence, becoming a destiny, and eventually a crucial indicator of its existence.

In other words,

【Isn't that how you're going to bestow [Fate] on me?】

In the <Star Stream>, modifiers are the very fate of that being.

【I expected you to say that. But strictly speaking, this isn't a 'modifier' I'm bestowing. I simply choose the piece of story that suits you.】

I understand what Bicheonhori meant. Both he and I are merely recorders of this <Star Stream>. And the one who completes the record is not the one who writes it, but the one who reads it.

【It's not me who grants you power—】

【It's the <Star Stream>, right?】

Then a series of modifiers appeared before my eyes.

1. The Scribe of the End.
2. Knight of Salvation.
3. Witness of Infinity.

Perhaps these three are the candidates for modifiers.

After I remained silent for a long time, Bicheonhori asked.

【Don't you like any of them?】

【All three clearly described me in some way.】

【If you don't like any of them, you can make one yourself.】

To make one myself.

Is that even possible?

【But in that case, it'll be difficult to properly receive the blessings bestowed upon a name. The <Star Stream> is inherently harsh on those who seek to change their own fate.】

【Can I delay choosing a modifier for a bit?】

【Is there something else urgent?】

Actually, even as I listened to Bicheonhori, my mind was busy with the external scenario.

According to what I heard from Cloud Mountain, right now wasn't the time for me to leisurely choose a name.

Bicheonhori looked at me intently and then blurted out,

【Is it because of the Mad Sword Emperor ?】

As expected, hiding one's true feelings in front of a high-ranking Recorder was difficult.

When I nodded, Bicheonhori said,

【It'll be too late even if we go to her now. The Constellations of the Giant Nebulae have begun to chase that child.】

I knew the Mad Sword Emperor was in dire straits. However, what I was curious about was how he was able to grasp the Mad Sword Emperor 's situation so thoroughly.

【Bicheonhori, how far are you recording?】

Even a high-ranking Recorder can't keep track of every scenario.

If he was focusing on the Mad Sword Emperor , a mere incarnation, then the implications were clear.

【Was it you who gave her the nickname 'Mad Sword Emperor'?】

【She's a character who will be named one of the 'Top 100 Strongest People' in this world.】

I hurriedly looked around. I had to get out of here immediately. It wasn't just any Recorder, but Bicheonhori who was watching over the story.

「The Mad Sword Emperor will soon face a serious crisis.」

It meant a story worthy of a Recorder's coveted record was about to begin.

【I have to go.】

【I told you. Even if you go now, you'll be late.】

I'm already eight years late. Even if I'm even later, I can't refuse to go just because I'm late.

Bicheonhori looked at me intently and said,

【There's one way you won't be late.】

I asked, trying to grasp what he meant.

【Do you know the exact location of the Mad Sword Emperor?】

【Is that all there is to it?】

A sudden realization dawned on me.

Bicheonhori was speaking. If I accept his offer, he'll tell me how to save the Mad Sword Emperor.

【What do you want?】

【I like how quickly you talk.】

Since we were just talking about 'modifiers', perhaps the deal was to ask me to choose one of the modifiers he'd created.

But Bicheonhori's offer was unexpected.

【Read the story records I wrote, and I'll tell you how to save the Mad Sword Emperor.】

【Read the records?】

Normally, I would have readily accepted. Even if it weren't his request, the records of a high-ranking Recorder were worth reading.

The problem was timing. Now wasn't the time to leisurely read his records.

【Didn't you want to know 'where the Mad Sword Emperor is now'?】

The moment I heard those words, a strange feeling struck me.

Where is she now?

Bicheonhori wasn't simply talking about the Mad Sword Emperor's 'spatiotemporal coordinates'.

「To truly understand someone's situation, you must ultimately understand their history.」

Bicheonhori was saying.

【If you truly want to save her, shouldn't you first understand why she came to the 'New Murim District'?】

Perhaps this was Bicheonhori's trap. He could be using my identity as a 'Kim Dokja fragment' to plot some kind of scheme.

【Understood.】

Even so, I had no choice. Perhaps it was because I, too, am a reader before being a writer.

【Show me.】

【Good thinking.】

Bicheonhori nodded readily, and a dazzling sentence began to float through the air.

「This is a story about a certain madness.」

The records began to be viewed.

---

With a ragged breath, the stories scattered. Perhaps it was the wounds from the previous clash. The skull mask covering her face rattled. She had to find a place to hide.

"Find her! She's nearby!"

Hidden deep within the abandoned building, the Mad Sword Emperor took a deep breath.

[The special ability, 'Immortal', is activated!]

If it weren't for the power of 'Immortal' inherited from her master, she would have collapsed long ago.

But even with this level of ability, dealing with the enemies pursuing her was no easy feat.

[The Constellations of the Giant Nebula <Olympus> are tracking you!]

[The Constellations of the Giant Nebula <Vedas> are tracking you!]

To make matters worse, the healing power of 'Immortal' was also hindered.

[Your incarnation is currently poisoned.]

Perhaps the previous blow had poisoned it. The vitality of 'Immortal' had been fighting the poison, but fighting them in this state was a desperate attempt to end in vain.

[The 'Recorder of Fear' supporting <Olympus Technology> is looking for you.]

More than anything, there were even 'Recorders' over there. Those who arbitrarily judge others' [Fate].

'There are only two options.'

Close your eyes, use the energy of the Elaine Forest, and lie down for two hours, or find an antidote.

After a moment of reflection, the Mad Sword Emperor called out to someone in her head.

'Can you hear me?'

She called out to the Constellation that had often helped her on her journey here. But the Constellation didn't respond.

He'd been busy with his own Constellation recently, so perhaps he didn't have time to worry about this.

'What would he have done?'

The thought struck her, and she smiled wryly.

'He would have found a way.'

She felt the urge to call his name. But perhaps it was the addiction. His name, his face, couldn't readily come to mind.

Consciousness was drifting in and out of her. In her somewhat hazy state, she felt like she was hallucinating.

"Why would Heewon do something like that? You could really die. You heard what it was like. Who the hell is that person?"

She had definitely heard something like that before. It must have been right before she entered the 'Fear Realm'.

She had to answer the questions of those who asked why she was going that far, whether there was a reason for her to do so.

"That is..."

But then she couldn't answer. She lacked the confidence to explain her feelings.

Perhaps that was why she felt compelled to act. She felt that once she saved him, she would understand why. If she met him again and looked into those gentle, narrow eyes, she might be able to explain her feelings.

[Your story mutters bitterly.]

But she had recklessly entered the 'Fear Realm', where she had nearly died several times. She couldn't believe that such terrifying monsters existed. If each and every one of them appeared in the scenario, it would be a catastrophe.

Nevertheless, confronting them, dodging them, and fleeing them—she steadily advanced deeper into the Fear Realm. When she reached the Entrance, the Middle Zone, and finally the entrance to the End Zone, she was certain.

「He is here.」

At the same time, she had a premonition.

「The Fear Realm is collapsing.」

The world was collapsing, as if crushed by powerful pressure. Beyond the collapsing world, a starlight she knew so well twinkled.

"Inho-ssi."

Jung Heewon started running. She ran, calling out the star's name, whatever it seemed to be.

"Kim Dokja!"

But the star was sucked away somewhere in the fierce storm. Jung Heewon ran frantically, chasing the starlight that vanished without a trace.

She had come all this way, vowing to save him, to bring him back.

"No..."

Watching the starlight scattering in the collapsing storm, Jung Heewon slowly sank to her knees.

The sound of a train could be heard from somewhere. A train carrying the Transcendents was departing, facing a disaster that would destroy a world.

Watching the train's tail dwindle away, Jung Heewon sank to her seat.

「I want to become strong.」

She wanted to become strong. She wanted to become strong enough to protect that person. That's why she swung her sword. She came here, wanting to return what she had received, what she thought she had received.

「Some salvation is completed not by the giver, but by the receiver.」

But she wasn't even given the chance to save that person.

「Her salvation ended here.」

With a sound like a rift in time buckling across an entire region, her world was washed clean.

But at the moment she had given up everything, a faint voice came from afar.

[No, Captain! If you jump from here—]

[Stop! Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!]

At first, she thought she'd misheard. But a moment later, something appeared to be running from the distant, pale landscape. A long shadow was running towards her.

A large hand suddenly reached out and grabbed her.

But the world was crushing her faster. The giant reached out with its other hand and forcibly opened the rift between the worlds, pulling her out. But in return, it lost one of its own arms.

「Even so, some salvation is only complete when you extend a hand.」

The giant's arm was torn apart with a bang. The giant, pouring out a story from one of its arms, asked her,

[Are you really going to die in a place like this?]

And so she met her master.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 924 Episode 52 Mad Sword Emperor (9)

Jung Heewon couldn't understand why the giant had saved her.

The giant ran, carrying her in its massive side.

[Your incarnation body is badly damaged.]

Only after the waves of destruction had barely moved away did the giant place Jung Heewon on the ground.

[If you continue like this, you will die.]

Jung Heewon knew this. Her incarnation body had already reached its limit. To reach the End Zone of the Fear Realm, she had exhausted her potential.

The reason she was still alive was clear.

[The story 'Regret, Exhaustion, Obsession', continues its storytelling.]

Her story was keeping her alive.

[What a peculiar story.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint looked closely at Jung Heewon and asked.

[Is there someone you wish to save?]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's 'Mirror Eyes' glowed brightly and began to read Jung Heewon.

[Are you perhaps an acquaintance of 'that child'?]

Jung Heewon slowly raised her head.

That child. Though the two syllables were nonsensical, Jung Heewon realized who it referred to.

"Do you know... Dokja-ssi?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint nodded heavily and continued her brief story.

A man who suddenly appeared in the 'Fear Realm' one day. He joined the Transcendent Alliance, confronted the Great Nebulae and the King of Fear, and ultimately fell into the final Time Fault.

"We must meet."

Jung Heewon struggled to get up, but her body wouldn't respond.

[I repeat, you will die soon.]

Jung Heewon despaired.

She finally heard the story of the person she had longed to meet.

[Become my disciple.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint spoke to her, who suddenly raised her head.

[If you inherit the 'immortality', you can survive.]

The moment she heard that voice, Jung Heewon instinctively realized. Perhaps she hadn't crossed this long path into the Fear Realm to meet this person.

Jung Heewon gasped for breath and asked,

"If I become your disciple, can I protect him?"

The words were so broken that it was impossible to understand. Nevertheless, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint discerned the meaning within them.

[Do you know what it means to protect someone?]

Jung Heewon shook her head, and Breaking the Sky Sword Saint spoke.

[If the person you wish to protect is attacked by a Constellation, you must fight that Constellation.]

Constellations. Jung Heewon now knew well about those terrifying stars.

[If the person you wish to protect is attacked by a Nebula, you must confront that Nebula.]

Nebula. A vicious group of terrifying Constellations.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint continued,

[If the person you wish to protect is attacked by a world, you must fight that world.]

"I know. That's exactly what I intend to do."

[I don't know how to protect someone.]

No one, not even Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, would know such a method. However, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint extended a large hand and added,

[But I can teach you how to fight alongside someone when they face the world.]

From that day on, Jung Heewon studied swordsmanship under Breaking the Sky Sword Saint near the Mid Zone of the Fear Realm.

[Breaking the Sky Technique, Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship, Red Phoenix Shunpo, Breaking the Sky Sword path.]

With her exceptional talent, she quickly mastered all of Breaking the Sky's techniques.

[It's been a long time since I've seen a student who has mastered the basics so well.]

A swordsman with no major strengths, but no bad habits. That was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's assessment of Jung Heewon.

It was only natural.

Since the scenario began, Jung Heewon had trained only one swordsmanship skill.

「Kendo.」

The path of the sword, to draw the fastest and most precise trajectory.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint observed her sword and showed her the path she should take.

[In the Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship, everyone shatters the heavens in different ways. Some shatter the heavens with flashy swordsmanship, while others cleave the heavens with an extremely refined single sword.]

She also heard a story about another disciple of the Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.

Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk.

The man she had been targeting, surprisingly, was her master's disciple.

"How much training does it take to become that strong?"

[That kid is special. He doesn't just have 'talent'.]

He doesn't just have talent.

Jung Heewon mulled over the meaning of that statement over and over again.

[Of course, you have incredible talent. It's been a while since I've seen an incarnation achieve 'transcendence' on their own.]

"But this isn't enough, is it?"

[What you need to overcome isn't his talent, but his time. If you want to beat him, you'll have to work several times harder than he does.]

"Still, that's the area I'm most confident in."

For several more years, Jung Heewon studied swordsmanship under the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. Through endless training and sparring, she learned the proper stance for the sword and how to confront the Constellations.

[This has taught you all the basics, so from now on, it's up to you.]

"These are only the basics?"

[The basics are enough. Those 'basics' are your greatest strength.]

"But I haven't yet broken the sky."

[To break the sky, you first need to understand what it looks like.]

"So you're saying I should carry out the scenarios?"

Ultimately, this world is made of stories.

[The story, 'Regret, Exhaustion, Obsession', wants to continue its storytelling.]

And in this world made of stories, all incarnations must walk toward the completion of their stories. Only those who walk this lonely and arduous path to the end can overcome the limitations imposed by the <Star Stream> and become true Transcendent beings.

[Yes, it's time to go back.]

With that, Jung Heewon and Breaking the Sky Sword Saint left the Fear Realm.

Looking at her master's large back as she walked ahead, one sleeve fluttering in the wind, Jung Heewon pondered.

「Why did master sacrifice her own arm to save her?」

Of course, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had already answered.

[Because that's what chivalry is.]

But Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's words were nothing more than a tautology.

[I saved you because I had to. That's all.]

Everyone knows that saving people is the right thing to do.

But is it really justifiable to sacrifice oneself to save someone just because it's the 'right thing to do'?

However, Jung Heewon liked Breaking the Sky Sword Saint in that way.

And it wasn't simply because she had saved her.

Her master, with her back straight, looked up at the sky. Her back, unfazed by any starlight, served as a kind of guide for Jung Heewon. Proof of how far a single incarnation could rise in this terrifying world of the Star Stream.

No matter what enemies appeared before them, she felt safe as long as she was with her master. Learning swordsmanship by her side and growing stronger—she felt she could become proud when she met him again.

And ironically, her small hopes were finally shattered upon arriving at the 'New Murim District'.

Constellations of the Narrative-grade surrounded her master.

The master, blood-red stories spilling from her eyes, faced a world to protect someone, and spoke.

[Run away, disciple.]

---

In a hazy state of consciousness, the Mad Sword Emperor suddenly regained consciousness. She couldn't remember when she'd lost consciousness.

Swish, stories poured out.

The shattered stories fell from her poisoned incarnation body. Her memories slowly reconstructed, and her master's last appearance came to her clearly.

「[Run, disciple.]」

An incarnation stronger than anyone she knew. She had reached the pinnacle of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship], a powerhouse who could even compete with the great Narrative-grade Constellations.

But even the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint couldn't stand against [Fate].

"You were hiding there, Mad Sword Emperor."

The Mad Sword Emperor reflexively activated [Vermilion Phoenix Divine Treasure]. The ruined building she had been hiding in collapsed under the slash.

The swirling dust clouds were like the chaos of her mind.

Like someone trying to escape from a chasing memory, the Mad Sword Emperor swung her sword. Her sword strikes were imbued with the stories she had experienced over the past few months.

「The time she lost her master and swung her sword like a madman.」

"I found it! It's Mad Sword Emperor! Kaaaaaaak!"

「The time she killed an ascendant.」

"This is crazy! Get out of the way!"

"She's almost at her limit! Push her!"

「Becoming a wanted person in the 'New Murim District' and being called 'Mad Sword Emperor'.」

"Too, too strong—"

"My arm! My arm! Aaaah!"

「Realizing the identity of the 'New Murim District', fighting against the corporations, and finally destroying the 'Orbital Elevator'.」

Even as the dust clouds turned into clouds of blood, the incarnations continued to surge forward without rest.

[The recorders cheering on the ascendants of the Giant Nebulae are watching you.]

The terminal incarnations of the Giant Nebulae. And the ascendants leading them were also visible.

Leading the charge were the Blood Jade Fist Demon Jo Jincheol and Paradise Saint Reinheit.

"As expected, she lives up to her reputation."

"Hahaha! We finally caught her, the Mad Sword Emperor!"

As they joined the battlefield, already in the early stages of the narrative stage, the Mad Sword Emperor gradually began to gain ground. It was difficult to fend off the attacks from the ascendants flying in from all directions. Blood spurted from her thighs and arms in an instant. Her breathing quickly reached the tip of her chin.

[Your incarnation body is in danger.]

Under normal circumstances, there would have been any way to escape. But now, her incarnation body was poisoned. Maintaining a prolonged battle with them was a huge burden.

'There's only one way.'

The Mad Sword Emperor grabbed a sword that had fallen to the ground and poured all her magical power into the blade.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.

Aura.

Breaking the Sky Ryu Seonggyeol.

The fragments of the sword shattered like meteors, piercing the bodies of the rushing ascenders.

"What—"

"Kwaaaaak!"

The golden energy of Breaking the Sky Ryu Seonggyeol swept through the battlefield like a storm. The unsuspecting ascendants rolled on the ground, clutching at their pierced chests, arms, and stomachs.

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', is astonished by the Mad Sword Emperor's might!]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is astonished by the Mad Sword Emperor's might!]

[The Constellations of the Giant Nebulae are astonished by the Mad Sword Emperor's might!]

[Beware.]

A force that could sweep away ascendants who had reached the Narrative-grade alone.

The Mad Sword Emperor, who had let out the breath she had been holding, began to stagger forward.

'I'll get out of here.'

But the moment she turned around and was about to activate [Vermilion Phoenix Divine Treasure], something grabbed her ankle.

She felt the hairs on her body stand on end.

She felt as if her feet were fixed to the ground, unable to move. She felt a blazing heat from somewhere, and then the ground around her began to burn.

A vision that set the world ablaze with just a glance.

The Mad Sword Emperor knew full well whose power this was.

[The Constellation, 'Flame of Purification', glares at you.]

Slowly turning her head, she saw the radiant incarnation of the Constellation there.

A storm of probability raged beneath the brightly open sky.

The Constellation descended upon the incarnation of the suffering ascender.

[The Constellation, 'Flame of Purification', descends upon the scenario area!]

A Constellation that surpassed even the Narrative-grade, looming over Myth-grade. One of the eight Lokapalas of the great <Vedas> was staring at her.

[Child, you have been too violent.]

The Flame of Purification, 'Agni'.

One of the Lokapalas of <Vedas> who had imprisoned her master that day.

The Mad Sword Emperor charged at Agni without hesitation.

If someone of the level of a Lokapala had appeared, there was nowhere to run. She had to confront her. Just like her master had done that day.

Transcendental Stage 4.

In an instant, her story exploded, taking over the entire area. The golden currents of energy contained in [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] surged forth.

Agni stared at the story of Breaking the Sky's swordsmanship flying towards him and said,

[Breaking the Sky Sword Saint has a remarkable disciple.]

A swordsmanship strong enough to rip through the flames of Agni, one of the Eight Lokapalas, and inflict damage on his incarnation.

[If only a few more years had passed, another transcendent that would scorn Constellations would have been born.]

It was a strike that would have been impossible to block if the target had been an ordinary Narrative-grade Constellation. Nevertheless, Agni parried the blow. It wasn't simply because Agni was a Lokapala of Vedas.

[You will die here.]

Because the laws of this world were not on the Mad Sword Emperor's side.

[The recorders of this scenario declare 'Fate'.]

Fate. The damned curse that had bewitched her master had just been placed upon her.

「The Mad Sword Emperor knew. She couldn't kill Agni now.」

「The poisoned incarnation body was breaking apart in real time.」

「The magical power, which had reached its limit, had long since been exhausted.」

Agni's two fists, momentarily on the defensive, moved as the sentences shackled her entire body. The Mad Sword Emperor groaned at the fists imbued with a distant story. The pain felt as if her grip was being torn apart.

「With her end before her, the Mad Sword Emperor thought.」

A fiery storm pounded through her entire body.

The shattered legend flowed ceaselessly from her.

「"Why did Heewon-ssi do that?"」

The fragments of the leaked legend swirled around her.

The question that had brought her here.

「"You could really die. You heard what kind of place it was. What exactly is that person?"」

She, speechless, was helpless before that question. But her sword answered her.

A sword she had swung to protect someone, or because she wanted to protect someone. That sword spoke for her.

「At least while she swung her sword for someone, she felt infinitely special.」

The thing that made her, a nobody, special.

It was once Cheon Inho, now Kim Dokja. Protecting him. The desire to protect him.

"I—"

Perhaps she hadn't sought him out for him. She simply wanted to continue feeling this special feeling.

「I saved you because I had to. That's all.」

At that moment, the Mad Sword Emperor seemed to understand, even a little, her master's words. 'I saved you because I had to' wasn't just about righteousness.

「I save because I must, and I protect because I must.」

The truly important reason for living is bound to be tautological.

Her knees buckled, and Agni's fist approached.

「It was finally the end of the Mad Sword Emperor.」

Even in her final moments, she didn't close her eyes. Instead, she stared proudly at the fist flying towards her.

Although she hadn't been able to protect what she wanted, she glared wide open to prove she hadn't given up.

And at that moment, Jung Heewon witnessed a strange sight.

「Finally it was the Mad Sword Emperor's end.」

A sight she could witness because she kept her eyes open until the very end.

Agni's fist was slowly slowing down.

「Finally it was the Mad Sword Emperor's end.」

The world was slowly becoming covered in black and white.

「Finally it was the Mad Sword Emperor」

Amidst a landscape as if pure white snow was falling, the sound of the rules of space and time breaking apart could be heard.

「Finally it was the Mad」

The sentences of [Fate] that had bound her were scattering. The skull mask covering her face clattered and fell.

「Finally」

What filled the void of her shattered fate was a single line written just for her in this world.

「Finally, Jung Heewon slowly raised her head.」

When had it been?

A small window had appeared before her eyes.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'The One Who Rewrites Eternity', requests a 'Recording Contract' from you.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 925 Episode 53 Record War (1)

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「"Whether we record it or not, what happened happened, and what will happen will happen. So, aren't you curious? Why, and for what purpose, do we strive to record stories?"」

—Bicheonhori King Weilong

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【You know, right? Even if we run at full speed now, we'll be late.】

Bicheonhori was right. Even if we escape the subspace right now and go rescue Jung Heewon, we'll be late.

By the time I arrive, the [Fate] of the Recorders will be fulfilled, and the heat of Agni, the Purifying Flame, will burn everything in the area, including Jung Heewon.

Fortunately, I had a way to resolve this spatiotemporal disparity.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins its storytelling!]

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', activates!]

Being located in the subspace created by Bicheonhori proved to be a great help.

【This space, strictly speaking, is a place created by processing 'dreams'. Therefore, it's an infinitely suitable space for you to use your 'power'.】

At this point, I'm starting to suspect if the whole thing wasn't just a ruse by Bicheonhori, but now I was in no position to be picky.

Furthermore, another obstacle remained. For [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] to activate, both I and the target had to think of each other simultaneously.

「Making her, who is nothing, special.」

Thankfully, the obstacle was naturally resolved.

「Once Cheon Inho, now Kim Dokja. Protecting that person. The desire to protect him.」

The moment I read that sentence, my breath caught in my throat.

Eight years had passed, but Jung Heewon still remembered me.

My heart pounded.

I could read her, leaning against that sentence. I would be able to see the world through her eyes once more.

I definitely should have.

[The connection with the target is currently not smooth.]

Why? Even though the activation conditions were met, the 'First-Person Viewpoint' didn't activate. What's the problem?

I turned around and saw Bicheonhori looking at me with a puzzled smile.

【Why, what's not working?】

That old man clearly knew I couldn't properly activate [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

【Is this why you called me here?】

【Heh heh, I don't understand what you mean.】

I let out a light sigh and concentrated. If I couldn't use [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], there was only one way to help her in this situation.

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

That was to manifest the 'power' of the Recorder of Fear.

「It was finally the end of the Mad Sword Emperor.」

The [Fate] emblem granted by the Recorders came to mind vividly, clinging to Jung Heewon like a binding.

I reached out for the emblem without hesitation.

Tsutsutsutsu.

The moment my hand touched it, sentences overflowed through my fingers like living loaches. I gripped the slippery words tightly and applied force. Then, the edges of the sentences I touched began to crumble.

「It was finally the end of」

Bicheonhori, who was watching me next to me, sighed.

【Surprising. Have you already realized the power of 'record'?】

The power to record the legends of characters in real time. To be precise, the power to force the history of a 'specific direction'.

That was the power of 'record' that the Recorders had.

The method itself was not difficult. With a feeling similar to when using the [□□] skill, I just need to twist the sentence that comes to mind into the shape I want.

Tsutsutsutsu!

Every time I intervened in the sentence, a threatening afterstorm rushed near me.

Maybe it's because they got wrong with the 'probability' that other Recorders put in.

[The 'Recorders' cheering for the Great Nebulae express their bewilderment at the reversal of their 'Fate'.]

[The 'Recorders' cheering for the Great Nebulae once again call out 'Fate'!]

I felt the context of the story shift violently. Sentences, swarming like insects, clung to my hand. The mere touch of their handwriting elicited a sense of discomfort.

I grabbed hold of the words once more and forcefully crushed them.

「The end of the Mad Sword Emperor」

This was the way the Recorders fought.

[The 'Recorders' cheering for the Great Nebulae look around!]

[The 'Recorders' cheering for the Great Nebulae have noticed your presence!]

A battle of records to determine the future of each character—in other words, their [Fate].

「The end of the Mad Sword」

Despite the Recorders' struggles, the dominance of the records was gradually shifting to my side. Of course, it's much easier to erase existing sentences than to write new ones.

[The probability of 'Fate' is distorted!]

[Some of the 'Recorders' cheering for the Great Nebulae are hit hard and retreat!]

Bicheonhori spoke, seeming to enjoy the scene.

【Indeed, you're no ordinary Recorder.】

【I just erased a few words.】

【The better the story, the harder it is to erase.】

It seemed like I'd heard something important, but I didn't have the presence of mind to respond.

Even if the binding power of [Fate] had weakened, Jung Heewon was still in danger. Before her stood Agni, the flame of purification, half-descended. Jung Heewon, whose incarnation body had reached its limit, was in a state of peril.

As if trying to help me, Bicheonhori spoke.

【There's no time. Although they've retreated for a moment, the Recorders over there are no pushovers. They'll prepare their position and pounce soon.】

【Isn't there a way?】

As if waiting for that, Bicheonhori added.

【If you sign a 'Record Contract,' you'll be able to describe the character's future with much less probability.】

I see.

I immediately attempted the 'Record Contract'. But...

[You cannot perform the 'Record Contract'.]

When I turned around, Bicheonhori said, still smiling.

【The 'Record Contract' is a sacred ritual. Only those who hold the 'Modifier' can perform it.】

It was then that I realized something.

That cunning fox knew from the beginning that I would sign the 'Record Contract' to save Jung Heewon.

In the end, I had to choose a 'Modifier' to help her.

1. Scribe of the End.

2. Knight of Salvation.

3. Witness of Infinity.

A dazzling beam of light floated before my eyes, accompanied by modifiers.

Bicheonhori must have foreseen this situation and created a modifier specifically for me.

[The name you chose will help you.]

If I choose one of these modifiers, I will receive the blessings of a high-ranking Recorder and overcome this crisis.

【Yes. I have chosen.】

A dazzling beam of light slowly floated before my eyes, accompanied by a modifier.

Bicheonhori stared at the modifier for a moment, then licked his lips and asked.

【Are you really going to make that choice?】

【You've been watching me all this time, so you must have anticipated what I would choose.】

Naturally, the modifier I chose wasn't the one Bicheonhori had suggested.

【You know the price of creating your own modifier, right?】

I nodded.

【The combination of words you chose is too heavy and harsh. I'll ask again. Are you really going to use that slur?】

【I'm prepared. I didn't become a 'Recorder' just to change a few words.】

What was on Bicheonhori's mind at my words? For a moment, something akin to worry flashed across his eyes.

【Being a Recorder doesn't mean you can escape 'Fate'. All we can do is change the sentence to 'interpret' the predetermined future differently.】

Interpreting the predetermined future differently... I said, mulling over the words.

【Even if it's just a play on words, a twisted interpretation is fine.】

If a writer decides to intervene in a character's [Fate], they must also be prepared. No matter what events, no matter what adversity befalls them, they must navigate the entire story together with their characters. Even if it ends in catastrophe.

【If someone reads that pun and believes it, it could become reality.】

We must keep in mind that that catastrophe could become the eternity of this world.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Rewrites Eternity', requests a 'Recording Contract' from incarnation 'Jung Heewon.']

The One Who Rewrites Eternity.

That was the 'modifier' I had chosen as a Recorder.

I looked at Jung Heewon on screen, anxious.

Please accept it.

But Jung Heewon on screen simply stared blankly at the message flashing before her eyes, a confused expression on her face.

【Oh, you make mistakes too.】

A mistake?

【Any good Recorder should first listen to how the character feels before writing the 'record' they desire.】

A series of facts belatedly came to mind.

Damn, I see.

【She lost her teacher to the [Fate] of the Recorders.】

I forgot about it for a moment in the urgency.

【If you suddenly offered her a recording contract in that situation, there's no way she'd accept it...】

Bicheonhori, who had been saying that, made a dumbfounded expression.

I, too, stared blankly at the screen. As if she could see me here, Jung Heewon was facing me across the screen.

「"...Dokja-ssi?"」

How could that be possible?

She was speaking to me, as if a character had broken through the [Fourth Wall].

「"It's Inho-ssi, right? It's you, right? Right?"」

It was unbelievable. Even from so far away, Jung Heewon had clearly sensed me.

Then, sparks flew from her eyes.

[The story, 'Regret, Exhaustion, Obsession', ripples.]

[The story, 'Regret, Exhaustion, Obsession', senses your presence.]

「ImustprotectImustprotectImustprotectImustprotectImustprotectImustprotectImustprotectImustprotectImustprotectImustprotect」

A brilliant ray of light burst, a faint link appearing between me and her.

['Record contract' has been signed.]

The world's landscape shifted, and Jung Heewon unleashed [Vermilion Divine Treasure] to dodge Agni's strike.

Perhaps it was because of her different movements from before, Agni frowned and asked.

[What have you done?]

I slowly opened my mouth, assessing Agni's predicament.

【Heewon-ssi, listen carefully. The situation is truly dire.】

I wasn't sure if she could hear me clearly. She had little magic left, and her incarnation body had long since reached its limit.

【Nevertheless—】

Still, I had to speak. I had to offer even the most obvious words of encouragement. Because in this world of stories, even the most obvious words can serve as a connecting adverb that turns the tide of battle.

【We can win.】

The enemy was no less than one of the Lokapalas of Vedas. A narrative-grade constellation comparable to Surya, the 'Supreme God of Light'.

「However, with Jung Heewon now having achieved the 4th stage of Transcendence, the odds weren't against her.」

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Rewrites Eternity', explains the strategy.]

If only we could properly record this battle—

[The constellation, 'Supreme God of Light', looks upon the Emperor of Light.]

[The constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', observes the Emperor of Light's battle.]

[The constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', cannot contain his excitement.]

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', observes your record.]

We will be able to obtain a 'Giant Tale' comparable to 「Demon World's Spring」 in this city.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 926 Episode 53 Record War (2)

【Ughh…!】

【Ooooh…】

The most expensive [Fate] they'd undertaken in the past few months was to cause a rain of cow dung to fall upon the incarnation of the God of Wine and Ecstasy, who had betrayed Olympus.

—Call [Fate] to the Mad Sword Emperor.

Meanwhile, a truly grand commission arrived. It was a request from the giant nebula <Veda> and <Olympus>.

—Tear her to pieces and kill her so she can never again interfere with the 'New Murim World'.

This commission was crucial.

The leader of the low-level recorder association, the 'Black Book Society', and the current orange-rank recorder, 'The One Who Draws the Question Mark', was planning to use this commission to 'promote his record'.

「If you reach the red rank, you can become an assistant secretary for a high-ranking recorder.」

Successful completion of the quest would allow him to work under the storied 'Fox Commanding the Sky' or the 'Demon King of the Cinema', adding footnotes to their records and becoming the 'Final Recorder'. It was definitely meant to be.

【Report. What on earth is going on?】

On the screen, the Emperor, freed from the bindings of the text, was dodging Agni's attacks.

The green mask, hastily rushing in, spoke.

【It seems an external recorder has interfered with [Fate].】

【I know. I mean, whoever it is.】

The [Fate] that had been declared had been erased, so it was natural for them to take a hit, but at the same time, ten recorders were put into a 'Recording Interruption' state.

【Is this the work of another syndicate?】

Even if they were low-ranking recorders, when ten recorders joined forces, the [Fate] became considerably more robust. This couldn't have happened unless some other record-keeping team had intervened.

【No. It was the work of a single recorder.】

【One recorder?】

The One Who Draws the Question Mark paused for a moment and asked.

【Has a high-ranking recorder appeared?】

But that couldn't have been the case. 'High-ranking recorders' had a pact not to interfere with the affairs of this 'New Murim District'.

【Unknown recorder. Doesn't seem to be high-ranking.】

【What's the modifier?】

【It's called the 'One Who Rewrites Eternity'.】

The One Who Rewrites Eternity.

It was a modifier he'd never heard of before.

That's when the screen in front of him began to flicker.

【Uh, a call from the giant nebula!】

The large screen flickered violently, and soon the face of a narrative-grade constellation appeared on the screen.

[What on earth are you doing?]

<Veda>'s Lokapala. It was the Flame of Purification, Agni.

[Why was Fate lifted?]

The recorders trembled, their lips trembling at the force transmitted through the screen. Even as a 'Recorder of Fear', it was still difficult for the lower-ranking recorders to handle the pressure radiating from a constellation of late-stage of narrative-grade.

Finally, the 'Question Marker' leaped from his seat and demonstrated his writing prowess, taking Agni's punishment for him.

【Please give us a moment. There's an obstacle.】

[Is it taking this long to kill an incarnation?]

He thought it was out of place for him to call out [Fate] just to kill a single incarnation, but the 'Question Marker' didn't show it.

[I'll take care of it right away.]

Perhaps even in <Veda>, they're overdoing it.

Even in a scenario in the 70s, it's quite improbable for a Lokapala-level constellation to 'descend' into a region with no connection.

[Remember. Your role is to properly record the stars' footprints. If I don't like the records, I can replace you at any time.]

Agni declared this and then unilaterally cut off communication.

【Those damned constellations...】

It was strange.

Even if they were arrogant constellations, they'd never been this rude to the Recorder Guild.

The green mask interjected, seemingly embarrassed.

【With all due respect, I hear Veda has been looking into other Recorder Guilds.】

【Another Guild? Where? Could it be the 'Backup Chronicle Guild'?】

【It seems to be the 'Afterglow Library' side.】

The Backup Chronicle Guild.

And the Afterglow Library.

All of these were the recorder groups that had declared [Fate] together during the previous 'Battle for the Demon King of Salvation'.

The 'The One Who Draws the Question Mark' spoke with a sob.

【We can't let those guys take our work away. Contact the obstructing recorder. There's no need for unnecessary sacrifices. Tell him you'll grant him his request if he just yields the Mad Sword Emperor.】

He doesn't know who the recorder obstructing the revision is, but judging by the fact that he sent tens of their recorders away after several revisions, it's definitely a monster.

Then it's wise for them to avoid confrontation as much as possible.

【Well, there's no response at all.】

【No response? Why?】

【It seems he's signed a 'recording contract' with the Mad Sword Emperor.】

【This damn thing.】

All recorders suffer a huge blow if the subject of their 'recording contract' dies. In other words, they can never yield.

But if they continue this deadlock, they'll eventually incur the wrath of the Great Nebulae.

Finally, the 'One Who Draws the Question Mark' made a decision.

【It's clear this guy is no ordinary recorder. However, unless you're a high-ranking recorder, abnormal revision abilities are limited to the 'contractor' of a 'recording contract'.】

All recorders naturally react more strongly to those with whom they have a 'recording contract'.

【Our goal is to eliminate the Mad Sword Emperor, so there's no need to limit [Fate] to the Mad Sword Emperor. Change the target of [Fate].】

Currently, the Lokapala of Veda has decided to use 'Half-Body Descent'.

【For the next five minutes, we will support Agni's 'Full Descent'.】

In that case, it would be a more strategic choice to use [Fate] on Lokapala to increase the likelihood.

Even if a high-ranking recorder intervenes, this [Fate] will be unstoppable.

【Let's erase the name of that recorder forever, along with the Mad Sword Emperor.】

---

「"Dokja-ssi."」

Jung Heewon bit her lip and stared into space.

It had already been five minutes since she had escaped the one-sided bombardment. Now, just standing still in Jung Heewon's incarnation body was a miracle.

[You truly amaze me, young incarnation.]

Agni was strong. A head-on collision would crush every bone in her body with a single blow.

「Still, Jung Heewon continued to move.」

Brightly glowing sentences supported her movements.

「The [Vermilion Phoenix], practiced tens of thousands of times, miraculously evaded Agni's attack.」

「The sword, never let go of her hand, deflected Agni's trajectory, imbued with a fatal force.」

Of course, I don't know how Jung Heewon lived.

But even without understanding her timeline, I can easily imagine. It was a fantasy possible only because I trusted her.

It was a sentence I could willingly write, believing that for the past eight years, she had undergone more rigorous training than I could ever imagine.

「The trajectory of the Heavenly Blade moved in her hand.」

Transcendental Stage 4.

The ultimate state, where, once fully mastered, one could stand a chance against even the most skilled constellations.

Kugugugugu.

The [Heavenly Blade Sword], barely activated, once again deflected Agni's fist. But now, it was her limit.

【If she pushes herself any further, her sword will break.】

Bicheonhori, who had been watching the entire battle with amusement, intervened.

I knew it. Jung Heewon couldn't fight anymore.

【Heewon-ssi.】

And my strategy was just beginning.

「'Are you sure?'」

Jung Heewon glanced up at the sky, as if to confirm my sincerity, then sighed lightly and her expression hardened. Then, with a strange smile on her face, she opened her mouth to Agni.

"Veda says there are only eight 'Locapalas', but how disappointing. Is this all there is? If it were the 'Supreme God of Light', he would have burned me to death long ago."

It was a provocation the usual Jung Heewon would never have made. And it was also a provocation the usual Agni wouldn't have succumbed to.

[You're talking funnily.]

But the current situation was a bit special. This fight was being watched by another Locapala of Veda.

[The constelation, 'Supreme God of Light' makes an intrigued expression.]

And then there were one of the twelve constellations of <Olympus> and a constellation of the narrative-grade from <Tamra>.

[The constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', bursts into mirthful laughter.]

[The constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', chuckles.]

Of course, if that were all, Agni wouldn't have been sincere.

[Many 'Recorders of Fear' are in the process of recording.]

This fight was being 'recorded' by the recorders.

In other words, no matter how this fight ended, it would inevitably remain as a 'story'.

[If you truly desire my wrath...]

Agni's expression contorted like a vicious evil spirit.

[It is the duty of 'Locapala' to lead you to 'liberation'.]

His entire body, which had once stood over ten meters in a half-ascension state, began to grow again.

Twenty meters, thirty meters, forty meters... a hundred meters. He had already towered higher than most buildings.

[Incarnations who worship Vedas, listen up.]

The incarnations who had been hiding nearby, watching the battle, looked up at the sky, bleeding from their orifices, at the resonating sound of the mantra.

[Those who do not wish to be liberated, flee this area immediately.]

The terrified incarnations screamed and began to flee. Both ascendants and non-ascendants alike fled in a panic.

Only Jung Heewon remained unmoved, witnessing the descent of the great god.

「The heavens open, and a black beast, uttering a terrible howl, descends.」

A gigantic black goat raced through the sky and descended to earth.

「A divine being, wielding an axe, sat down on the ornately decorated black goat.」

Who could dare confront that being?

「He has three faces and many arms, yet he wears a crown of blazing flames.」

Just meeting his gaze felt like my entire body was on fire.

「He is the god of fire, Agni, the flame that purifies the universe.」

That was the true form of Agni, the god of fire, standing shoulder to shoulder with the 'Supreme God of Light'.

The moment I saw him, I was certain.

This wasn't a battlefield as plausible as the 'Great Battle of Good and Evil'.

For a power so close to its true form to be revealed in such a place meant someone else was helping.

[Many Recorders of Fear contribute to the depiction of the 'Flame of Purification'.]

Probably the work of the Recorders.

"Dokja-ssi. That..."

In scenario 70, a one-on-one confrontation with 'Locapala', who was close to complete descent. It was a truly desperate situation, but I didn't panic.

【Yes.】

Probably the same for Jung Heewon.

【I guess we've passed the point where we can call him a 'human'.】

Agni's transformed incarnation now looked less human and more like some other species.

Jung Heewon nodded and said,

「"I suppose it's more correct to think of it as a monster."」

[Exclusive skill, 'Time of Judgment', activates!]

The characteristics of the Judgement trait.

'Judge of Destruction', which activates against monsters, began to shine.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 927 Episode 53 Record War (3)

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Kugugugugu.

I could hear the sound of probability gathering around the request to activate [Time of Judgment]. However, it wasn't a moment to relax.

The key activation condition for [Time of Judgment] requested by the 'Judge of Destruction' was 'the consent of all the Constellations within the channel'.

If even one Constellation consents to the activation, [Time of Judgment] will be activated.

【Heewon-ssi, please tell him exactly what I say from now on.】

Watching Jung Heewon nod across the screen, I observed the constellation's reactions.

[Some Constellations shook their heads.]

[A very small number of Constellations question the appropriateness of viewing the 'Flame of Purification' as a 'monster'.]

The reactions were as expected.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', asks if he's a monster at that level.]

Of course, there were other Historical-grade Constellations, including 'Bald General of Justice', who were sympathetic to us, but even they weren't likely to agree to [Time of Judgment].

For a Historical-grade Constellation, not even a Narrative-grade, to oppose a massive Nebula would be to invite disaster.

Agni laughed, perhaps thinking we were cornered.

[It was an interesting strategy, but do you dare think there's a star that can oppose <Vedas>?]

As Agni had said, the sky was calm to the point of indifference. It was only natural.

No Constellation here would think Jung Heewon could defeat Agni.

But I wasn't fazed.

"There are no Constellations, but there are incarnations."

Jung Heewon calmly recited the lines I had given her.

"If the Supreme King were here, he wouldn't have said such things."

Agni looked down at Jung Heewon, as if she were saying something out of the blue. Jung Heewon, who was actually saying it, looked somewhat worried.

She probably doesn't understand why I made her say that.

I didn't really explain.

Because—

"Supreme King? Did you just say Supreme King?"

The reason I made her say that had just appeared from among the ruins.

"Mad Sword Emperor! I knew it! You really knew something about the Supreme King!"

Nirvana, the leader of the Salvation Church, had been chasing the Mad Sword Emperor. He had finally appeared on the battlefield.

"Tell me! What on earth do you know? Why are you using the Supreme King's swordsmanship!

Agni's expression twisted at the unexpected intruder.

[Is there a child who hasn't run away yet?]

"You cheeky Constellation, isn't this body speaking right now?"

As expected, Nirvana, in a fit of madness for Yoo Joonghyuk, remained undaunted even before that Narrative-grade Constellation.

Agni murmured, glancing at Nirvana with a strange gaze.

[Is that Seokjun's pet?]

Agni sighed softly, perhaps because rumors about Nirvana had already spread to Vedas.

[I'll close my eyes once I see him. Get out.]

Agni unleashed his power, and a heavy burden fell over the area once again.

Nirvana's expression hardened for a moment, then reacted.

"Are you ordering me to do this?"

Even though he was the Leader of the Salvation Church, his opponent was a Constellation of the 'Late Stage Narrative-grade'. Even though running away was not something to be ashamed of, he showed no signs of retreating. Then it's time for someone to light the fire.

"Savior. If you help me here, I'll give you what you want."

Jung Heewon repeated my words, and Nirvana cheered.

"Good. Mad Sword Emperor! Then become one with me and—"

"The regression of the Supreme King ends with this Round."

Nirvana's eyes slowly dilated.

"If you want to hear more, save me."

The next moment, Agni's fiery heat enveloped my vision.

Thankfully, a palm pierced through the fierce flames, protecting the two. Nirvana's [Thousand-Armed Avalokiteshvara] had activated.

"What do you mean? This Round is the end? Where on earth did you hear that?"

Nirvana, glaring, added in a faintly dazed voice.

"And… why do I smell my 'follower' on you?"

I smiled bitterly. As expected of a reincarnated being, he's quick-witted.

[Foolish mortals...]

Agni's fiery anger was intensifying.

But even Nirvana was no easy opponent.

"I'm not a mortal, but a reincarnated being, you foolish Constellation."

「Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara, charging forward with a desperate resolve, blocked the fiery anger.」

Of course, even Nirvana wouldn't be able to defeat Agni. At best, he'd only be able to hold out for a few minutes.

I had to make good use of the precious time he'd given me.

【Are you planning to use that 'method' from earlier?】

Bicheonhori already seemed to know what I was planning.

【That method?】

【A method to temporarily become a Constellation.】

【What you mentioned is a good method, though.】

If I activate 'Demon King of Salvation Mode', I can temporarily wield powers equivalent to a 'Constellation'. Then, perhaps, even briefly, it might be possible to agree to [The Hour of Judgment]. But...

「A deep, bloody scent burned from the distant stories Agni lived in.」

「The blood of the living creatures he slew with his own axe filled the surroundings like fog.」

「The ceaseless, pulsating heat burned the fog, like waves...」

The sentences of the recorders flowed in real time. The pace of the sentences was so fast that catching and erasing them one by one seemed impossible.

At that moment, a peculiar sentence flashed before my eyes.

「Agni often glanced warily at the sky. As if he was reluctant to allow anyone to interfere in this battlefield.」

【If my thoughts are correct, there will be a Constellation that will aid us.】

【Are you waiting for <Kim Dokja Company> or the Constellations of other worldlines?】

How wonderful that would be.

I shook my head with a wry smile.

【This time, it's a different Constellation.】

【There's no way a Constellation could stand against Agni.】

"Gyaaaaaaaah!"

Finally, unable to withstand Agni's heat, the [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara] melted.

【No, there is.】

[The activation conditions for 'Hour of Judgment' have been met.]

Amidst the message, a terrifying energy wave surged from Jung Heewon's body. Jung Heewon leaped up in one breath and activated [Vermilion God's Treasure], striking with a flash of lightning.

The black goat Agni was riding let out a cry as if in a fit of convulsion. A pitch-black story leaped into the air. Agni muttered in shock.

[No way—]

The moment he raised his head, a single Constellation shone brightly in the sky.

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', consents to the activation of 'Hour of Judgment'.]

Dionysus, God of Wine and Ecstasy. He agreed to Jung Heewon's [Time of Judgment].

Agni glared and unleashed a mantra.

[Foolish prodigal son of Olympus! How dare you side with that incarnation?]

Dionysus also unleashed an indirect message at that terrifying mantra.

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', pretends otherwise.]

Even if Dionysus was one of the twelve gods of Olympus, confronting the Locapala of Vedas head-on was a risky undertaking.

Nevertheless, Dionysus chose the 'Mad Sword Emperor'.

【Suddenly, 'Dionysus'?】

I smiled, and Bicheonhori asked, his voice threatening.

【Could it be that you planned this? Since when?】

【Since I heard the information from 'Moral'.】

Moral said. Dionysus is currently independent from Olympus. In that situation, I was certain he would take a different path than the existing Olympus.

【Could it be that you used [Fate] on Dionysus?】

【Similar.】

【Even if it were [Fate], it wouldn't be possible to force the choice of a Narrative-grade Constellation.】

That's right. Even for a Recorder, manipulating a Narrative-grade being by imposing [Fate] on them is nearly impossible. [Fate], granted improbably, has its limits, and above all, all characters possess 'free will'.

【I didn't force it.】

I shrugged and showed him the sentence I'd written.

「Dionysus thought. 'Mad Sword Emperor. A Transcendent that chooses a direct confrontation with Agni, the Lokapala?'」

Bicheonhori glared at my sentence,

as if trying to discern some hidden interpretation beneath the words.

【This is all there is to the [Fate] you wrote?】

My task was simple: to make Dionysus interested in the Mad Sword Emperor.

【Dionysus will undoubtedly need a new 'base' after the independence of <Olympus>.】

For now, I thought that was enough.

Just by making him aware of the Mad Sword Emperor, Dionysus would have deemed her useful in the 'next scenario'. Bicheonhori exclaimed in admiration.

【You're truly crazy.】

【Thank you for the compliment. Please donate some coins.】

The atmosphere on the battlefield changed with Dionysus' intervention.

Kugugugugu.

Her body, strengthened to the limit by the power of [Time of Judgment], Jung Heewon's sword began to move as if dancing.

「It's not enough.」

The trajectory of the [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship], which she had swung tens of thousands of times every day, was becoming darker.

Faster, stronger. Listening to her thoughts, I slowly closed my eyes. The stage was set, so it was my turn to step forward.

「What does it take for a character to unleash their full potential?」

Bichonhori said.

【I can't give you coins, but I can lend you a line or two.】

With that, a phrase flashed through my mind. It was a line from Bicheonhori, author of 「The 100 Strongest」.

「"You can't always say life is better than death."」

A line from Jung Heewon, who was simply called the 'Mad Butcher', unable to even find her own name in the main story.

「"It would be even more so if there was nothing to protect."」

The story of her suffering, unable to protect what was precious, had been passed down across the worldline to this place.

「IhavetoprotectIhavetoprotectIhavetoprotectIhavetoprotectIhavetoprotect...」

A round that seemed to continue on for eternity. Beyond the thoughts, I felt as if I could grasp the years she had lived. Bicheonhori added with a pleased smile.

【As expected, what strengthens a stage is 'repetition' and 'utilization'.】

Above the maddening prelude laid by Bicheonhori, the history she and I had built began to flow.

「"Heewon-ssi... I love you... It's true..."」

「"What are you doing?"」

The moment I first met her at Geumho Station.

「"Can you support me from behind?"」

「"I'd love to, but my arms are like this."」

「"Support me with your back. Like this!"」

The time we were eaten by a Sea Commander and, after many twists and turns, escaped together.

「"Good job, Heewon-ssi."」

And the death of Sergeant Jung Moonho at Seoul Station.

Even the moment we witnessed the sound together.

「That's how Jung Heewon became the 'Mad Sword Emperor'.」

I intervened in her life, and she willingly became my story. She became a sword, unbreakable by any tragedy.

So now, she and I were thinking the same thing.

「I will never let you die.」

We will not let each other die.

「The Axe of God and the Sword of Man clashed in the air.」

The scenery distorted, and a violent thunderbolt struck the sky.

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', cannot take its eyes off the battle.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', stops wiping his head.]

[The Constellation, 'Lying Dragon' closes the book he was reading.]

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries, widens his eyes.]

All the Constellations in the channel were focused on the battle, perhaps not expecting such a bloody battle in just scenario number 70.

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', cannot take his eyes off the battle between gods and humans.]

The pure power of the story, captivating even the Constellations of the Giant Nebulae and the small and medium Constellations.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God, has entered the channel.]

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God, feels a strange sense of deja vu during your battle.]

[The <Star Stream> begins to show the presence of that area.]

As the stage grew larger, the density of probability filling Agni's entire being also increased.

[With just such a piece of history.]

A divine strike, peeking at the Myth-grade position. An axe engulfed in fiery flames struck the ground. Nirvana, caught in the raging winds of red flame, collapsed on the ground without even a scream.

A god's shadow fell over Nirvana's incarnation body.

[Do you truly believe you can stand against a 'god'?]

Nirvana struggled, trampled by Agni.

The vastly longer history between gods and humans unfolded before our eyes.

「As the flames engulfed the land, the mountain ranges blackened like giant altars, and rivers evaporated and rose into the sky. Countless starlights were absorbed and scattered by the flames, and even the sun wavered before them like a faint lantern.」

「What I heard was the language of fire, the heartbeat of the universe as flames collided with each other.」

「Purification is Agni's declaration of liberation. Mother Nature's command to be purified by fire and reborn.」

A force that became [Fate] simply by repeating history.

I saw Bicheonhori shaking his head.

【It was an interesting fight, but it was a match that was impossible from the start.】

「The God of Flame was there.」

Even I, looking beyond the screen, felt a shiver. An enemy that even a Transcendent Stage 4 [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] couldn't cut.

I saw Jung Heewon's face darken, biting her lip.

【You provoked the Constellations too much. The Flame of Purification is a 'Locapala'. Did you really think a mere incarnation could defeat him, who was on the verge of Mythical promotion?】

Perhaps it was something I wouldn't have done before. Using Jung Heewon to provoke the Constellations and expand the stage—there was absolutely no benefit to doing something like that right away.

【What on earth were you thinking…?】

But right now, this was the only way to save Jung Heewon.

【This is my thought.】

[The aftershock of probability is coming!]

The excessive abuse of probability finally led to the aftershock of probability.

Agni frowned and stared into the sky.

[The 'Balance of Probability' is beginning to tip!]

Due to the intervention of the Recorders and the Giant Nebulae, Agni used probability beyond what was permitted in the 'New Murim District'.

「The scales of probability are fair, so if one side of the scale tilts, a corresponding 'probability' is inevitably opened up on the other side.」

In other words, the conditions for a being comparable to Agni to be powerful in this city have just been met.

[The 'Great Hall' is being created!]

The sky in the scenario turned pitch black, and the 'Great Hall' appeared.

I said.

【The 'Great Hall' has the characteristic of summoning 'otherworldly deities' with deep temporal, spatial, and lore ties to the area.】

「And the 'Outer God' most closely connected to this 'city' is...」

Tsutsutsu, a portal swirled open before my eyes.

[The story, 'King of Fear' is with you.]

The scenario was calling me.

【Watch closely, Bicheonhori.】

I glanced at Bicheonhori, who was glaring at me, and stepped into the portal.

【Because the ending I'm about to write begins here.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 928 Episode 53 Record War (4)

Two piercing eyes twinkled in the pitch-black darkness of the theater.

The sound of someone regularly knocking on the theater door. Asmodeus ignored the noise and focused on the screen.

「"Haha, hahahaha! I, I can become strong now! You son of a bitch, Kim Dokja! You didn't know that!"」

A man shouted on the screen. A middle-aged man, splattered with demon blood, was stabbing the fallen 'Dark Guardian' with a groundhog knife.

「"Immortality? You idiot! What kind of immortality is immortality in a world like this? That's why someone like you can't be a leader! Do you understand—"」

Thump, thump, thump. The knocking on the theater door grew louder. Asmodeus frowned, sighed in annoyance, then turned off the screen and opened the theater door.

【What's going on, Hermit?】

'Hermit' was an Assistant Recorder Asmodeus had recently recruited. While his writing style was gloomy, he demonstrated a talent for manifesting [Fate] in shorthand, and he was thought to be a useful one to have.

He seemed somewhat self-conscious, but he was relatively reserved. He had achieved the 'Red' rank in Bicheonhori's Record Archive, so I thought it wouldn't be a problem to recruit him...

【I told you not to come unless it was urgent.】

【Excuse me. Demon King of the Cinema, I have an urgent report to make.】

Asmodeus watched Hermit rambling on faster than he could transcribe [Fate], deciding to listen to his story.

【...In Bicheonhori's 'Record Archive'? Is that true?】

【Yes.】

A summary of Hermit's words was as follows.

A Recorder wearing a 'white fox mask' appeared in Bicheonhori's subspace, the 'Record Archive'. But the mysterious Recorder had 'traded' information that sounded unusual at first glance.

【The food the Oldest Dream hates? Was he really suggesting a 'trade' using that information?】

【Yes, so...】

【Ahaha.】

Asmodeus's sudden laughter made Hermit look puzzled. Asmodeus cleared his throat slightly and added,

【I'm curious. That archive: which city is it connected to?】

At Asmodeus's expression of interest, Hermit's voice brightened significantly.

【The access point for that archive is—】

It was then that a small murmur was heard from a corner of the theater.

「Oh—」

A child's singing voice. While Hermit paused at the strangeness in the voice, the other children in the audience began to speak one by one.

「O o o o o o o o」

The children sang in unison.

A strange probability gripped the theater.

Hermit, feeling a terrible dizziness, stumbled.

【Ah.】

He looked up and saw Asmodeus, his expression enchanted.

As if he had forgotten the story he had been hearing, Asmodeus left Hermit behind and trudged to the audience, where he collapsed.

A moment later, a video began to appear on the torn theater screen.

「...The King of Fear is strong...」

The mere sound of the chorus made his stomach churn. The story of 'Fear' resonated within Asmodeus, and he began to cry.

【I see. A truly fitting return for you.】

Above the 'New Murim District', the King of Fear descended.

The shrieks of the Recorders of Fear. Even amidst all this, the desperate struggle of the Recorders continued, trying to write down even one more sentence.

「The forgotten Watcher of Dreams has finally revealed himself.」

「The master of the temporal rift, revered by all the stars...」

「The boy from the old house, resonating with the sorrow of the vanished...」

Gazing upon the battlefield on the margins, where the desire to write, read, and survive swirled, Asmodeus spoke to the Hermit, who was leaning against a corner of the theater, trembling.

【Look, Hermit. This world is a 'one-line battle'.】

A single line determines life and death, a single line writes someone's [Fate]. And a single line can determine the end of a world.

The crucial question is who writes that 'last sentence' and how.

【The end of the worldline is truly near.】

'Constellation hunting' was beginning.

---

「"Don't use the 'Second Mode'."」

The moment I activated the story, I instinctively recalled Han Sooyoung's words.

「"Your 'Second Mode' is still unfinished. If you misuse it, you might be consumed by the story."」

The second mode Han Sooyoung spoke of was to borrow the power of the 'King of Fear'.

[The story, 'King of Fear' is resonating with you.]

The moment I stepped into the 'Great Hall', the darkness of the world spoke to me.

【Oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh oh】

The screams of Outer Gods scattered throughout the <Star Stream>. Distant Outer Gods, scattered across each worldline, gazed upon me.

【Ki ng of Fear】

Even though I would normally panic, I wasn't afraid. Perhaps it was because I subconsciously realized they weren't hostile to me.

【Wel co me to our play grou nd】

Of course, not all Outer Gods were so welcoming.

【The scent of cons tel la tions】

【You are ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■…?】

The next moment, with an incredible spark, a story flowed out from within me.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', wields his power.]

[The Giant Tale, 'Season of Light and Darkness', begins its storytelling.]

The Second Kim Dokja's main story, the Giant Tale, 'Season of Light and Darkness', was stirring.

A context incomparably more distant than the existing stories began to sweep through me.

「The 'Giant Tale' is like a natural phenomenon. Its story does not compromise with the incarnation, but only realizes itself through the incarnation's body.」

Amidst the searing pain in my brain, my sense of self gradually became blurred.

Is this why Han Sooyoung told me not to use it? I desperately recalled the story of the 'Second'. To master this story, I needed to emulate its master, even if only a little.

「Who is the 'King of Fear'?」

The source of the <Star Stream>—a being born from fragments of the 'Oldest Dream'. The master of the 'Time Fault' who dreams and delights in interpreting them.

Everyone who has ever recorded his life struggles to leave behind even a single line of interpretation, and every star that has seen him retreats in a fear that light cannot interpret —

「The Strangeness of the <Star Stream>.」

Unlike the First, who was somewhat talkative, I rarely spoke to the Second.

However, I remembered the scenery I had seen with him in the 'Big House'. His feelings about the 'Time Fault'. His Outer Gods—the compassion he showed to Outer Gods. His curiosity that did not ignore the stories of mere extras or villains.

「He was a monster born to love all stories.」

Merely maintaining my existence felt like my mind would collapse.

Barely holding onto my senses, I walked the path of the 'Great Hall'.

A path of stars and darkness. Through gazes mingled with fear and awe, the exit from the 'Hall' finally came into view.

「The 'King of Fear' will once again listen to stories.」

Ashen shade seemed to descend upon every landscape of the world.

「The King of Fear, who sees the world with his eyes closed and hears the truth with his ears plugged, will descend.」

Living things burned to death, not even a single collar left. The traces of all beings fading away were trampled upon my eyes.

「I hate sadness.」

This was the world the 'King of Fear' had seen.

[Nonsense, nonsense—]

The God of Flames, burning the earth, looked up in astonishment.

[There's no way that evil being could still be alive—!]

Have you ever seen a god terrified?

[A very small number of Constellations are attempting to leave the channel!]

I was watching.

「"If you must reveal your power early..."」

While all living things that felt 'fear' were hesitant to raise their heads, I slowly walked toward the God of Flame.

「"Show them the difference in strength clearly. No one in the <Star Stream> can ignore you. That's how you protect what's precious to you."」

The presence of the 'King of Fear' filled the entire 'New Murim District'.

「E xis tence Void E xis tence Void E xis tence Void E xis tence Contribution」

「Light Rem nants Light Rem nants Light Rem nants Light Rem nants」

「To■toto■toto■toto■toto■toto■toto■toto■to」

The maddened Recorders were spewing out meaningless sentences, confronted by a fear they couldn't interpret.

Agni, too, was watching me, reading something entirely different.

「The man who saw the end of a world was there.」

The end of the world. The scene of the 'Final Wall' reached twice through the 'King of Fear'. The possibility of an apocalypse that all Constellations both awe and fear.

[Th- Aaah, Aaaaaaah—!]

The god, having glimpsed this possibility, began to shed tears of blood from his entire body.

[Some of the Recorders of Fear are fleeing the scenario battlefield!]

Some of the Recorders, sensing ominousness, finally attempted to escape the scenario.

【Bihyung.】

At my call, sparks swept across the entire 'New Murim District'.

[The Administration temporarily prohibits departure from the scenario in this area.]

[The 'Recorders of Fear' in this area are in deep confusion!]

I will not let a single one escape. I will not let you escape the sentences you wrote. I will not let you ignore the old sorrow.

「The backlash of the destroyed [Fate] will return to those who unleashed it.」

With every step Agni took, the groans of the Recorders seemed to echo in my ears.

[The Giant Nebula, <Vedas>, cannot hide its bewilderment at your presence.]

[The Giant Nebula, <Vedas>, provides additional probability!]

Agni, barely regaining his composure after receiving the probability from <Vedas>, shouted as he endured the aftershock of probability.

[Recorders. Do not panic. That's not the real 'King of Fear'. He's already dead. His death has already been recorded! That's nothing more than the remains of a dead Fear—!]

He was right. Right now, I couldn't use the overwhelming power of 'Fear' that the 'King of Fear' had displayed.

His sanctuary, the Fear Realm, had already been destroyed, and the 'Time Faults' he controlled had all been closed.

Now, I was just Kim Dokja, wearing the 'King of Fear's' clothes.

[The Recorders of Fear begin to repair the records!]

Like cornered rats, the Recorders were gathering again. Now, they too were desperate.

It was only natural. If Agni died here, they would die too.

Looking at the Recorders, I quietly smiled.

「They have no idea what the 'King of Fear' is.」

They would now understand what it meant to achieve a balance of probability with the great Lokapala simply by 'existing'.

I slowly opened my mouth.

【Fox That Commands the Skies, Bicheonhori King Weilong.】

As if the world had stopped, all words in the world fell silent before the tranquil mantra.

【Demon King of the Cinema, the Demon God of Wrath and Justice Asmodeus.】

The sky turned pitch black, and the Constellations held their breath. The Recorders, who had stopped recording, focused on my words.

【A warning to them and all 'Recorders'. Whoever stands in my way, whoever dares to write [Fate] before me—】

As if engraving a mantra into their souls, I record their fear.

【That [Fate] will be your final sentence.】

This is a kind of apocalypse.

Agni shouted hysterically.

[Don't listen to nonsense. He is merely a shell. According to the information just now coming down from the Nebula…!]

And in the next moment, an unusual aftershock began to ripple through his body.

[What?]

The sentences surrounding him were disintegrating. All the stories that had reinforced, praised, and protected his probability were crumbling.

「In an instant, Agni realized what had happened.」

Agni, astonished, hurriedly turned and glanced into the empty air.

[<Vedas>! Right now… !]

「The power of the 'King of Fear', the 'End that No One Can Ignore'.」

With this power, all the Recorders in this scenario area have just heard 'information they should not hear'.

[All 'Recorders of Fear' entangled in the 'Fate' proclamation of the 'New Murim District' are now in a 'Recording Interruption' state.]

Agni's incarnation, strengthened by the Recorders' [Fate], weakened, and the god's incarnation, unable to contain the probability condensed within, began to swell.

[An...!]

With a blast of probability, Agni's entire body exploded before my eyes.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 929 Episode 53 Record War (5)

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[The Recorder of Fear, '...', is unable to overcome the shock of the recording interruption...]

[The Recorder of Fear, '...', lets out a terrifying scream...]

...

It was the first time I'd ever witnessed such a violent storm of messages.

The sentences that had been strengthening Agni shattered beyond recognition, and Agni's story, which had filled the incarnation body, swelled and burst forth.

[Gaaaaaaaaa!]

Agni's roar echoed through the scene, resembling a volcano erupting.

[Many Constellations within the channel are shocked!]

<Olympus>, <Vedas>, and the other Constellations of the 'New Murim District' were all engulfed in the suffocating atmosphere.

A moment later, a staggering shadow of a god appeared through the acrid smoke.

[I, can't, forgive... ]

Is the Constellation that reached 'Lokapala' truly different?

Even after being struck by that horrific aftershock, Agni remained alive. Although severely damaged and reduced to less than half his size, he still radiated a force befitting a great man.

Agni, staggering, swung his broken axe at me.

[Only you—]

Even if his strength had been diminished, it was a threatening blow for me, who still lacked the full power of the 'King of Fear'. But I didn't panic.

「The 'fighter' who protects the King of Fear will be there.」

The Mad Sword Emperror, which had endured through the ages to avenge its master, was rushing toward me.

「The sword, tinged with the light of the spirit, cut through the god's waist.」

The trajectory of Jung Heewon's [Breaking the Sky Sword] swung slashed Agni. The dehorned goat collapsed with a groan, and the god's massive body collapsed to the ground. Jung Heewon, exhausted of all her power, collapsed to the ground, as if leaving it to me.

His upper and lower body severed by the Breaking the Sky Sword, Agni’s voice leaked out from the cracks in the shattered stories.

["No, no, no…"]

Even the last of his pride, his mantra, crumbled, and the great star's wretched inner self was revealed to the world.

["Don't look at me! I said don't look!"]

A star so dazzling that even a glimpse was impossible. Where its brilliance had faded, a grotesque figure lay.

It was a tiny baby.

Its skin burned as if scorched by fire. A pitch-black body soaked in oil. From its small head, long-rotted, rotten eyeballs oozed out.

For a Constellation that had lived a life of feasting on stories, perched atop the great heavens, its true form was absurdly pitiful.

[You have achieved a wondrous feat!]

[A new 'story' has sprouted for you!]

[The growth response of the story accelerates with your wondrous achievements!]

[A new story has been born!]

Hunting 'Lokapala', the reward for that achievement was appearing before my eyes in real time.

[You have acquired the story, 'Witness to the Truth of the Stars'.]

[The story is of 'Semi-mythical' grade.]

[Another story related to this achievement is sprouting.]

I approached Agni, feeling the pulsating story.

Agni was crawling desperately. He was desperately trying to survive, to get as far away from me as possible.

【Flame of Purification.】

I called out his modifier. I accurately analyzed the Constellation context and grasped his true name.

【One of the eight cardinal directions of the Vedas. The seat of the southeast. Agni, who eats oil.】

His expression, soaked in fear, trembled, as if he already knew the [Fate] he had been given.

【I understand your sorrow.】

The King of Fear's other power is 'collection'. All beings who succumb to him and become 'Fears' are trapped in the 'Time Fault' he created.

【I hate sadness. So—】

Agni's story began to be sucked into my hands.

Agni, the flame of purification, his brilliant history as a Lokapala of the Vedas entangled with my fingertips.

【That's all I need to say.】

A shadow floated over Agni's expression. The shadow of a wall filled with distant strings began to envelop his soul.

「His ■■ was written there.」

["Ah, ah. Aaaah—"]

The Constellation cried out like a newborn baby. His trembling body seemed to reject its own ■■, yet at the same time, it seemed to finally accept it.

The soul of the Constellation, facing eternal rest, was dispersing. All of its records were seeping into that distant 'Time Fault'.

But at that moment...

[Stop.]

Someone stopped me.

A Constellation radiated a light far more divine than Agni's flame, though not as fiery.

[Wouldn't that be better? Wielding that 'power' would be a great burden even for you.]

I thought I heard a train whistle coming from somewhere.

He was so powerful that he could face me in 'King of Fear' mode. The dazzling light emanating from his entire body proved who he was.

[Foolish humans, unaware of the exaltation of the throne of God.]

The Constellation of Vedas that had stopped Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk in the Demon Realm.

【Supreme God of Light.】

The strongest Lokapala, rivaling Agni. The Supreme God of Light, Surya, directly attacked the 'New Murim District'.

[The constellation, 'Supreme God of Light', gazes upon you.]

Amidst the overwhelming whirlwind of probability, I suddenly realized what had happened.

「I thought it was strange.」

The moment Agni exploded, caught in the aftershock of probability, the scales of probability should have tilted back toward me. The opposite scale had lost its opponent, a worthy opponent for my 'class'.

But the scales didn't tilt, and the aftershock didn't blow.

「Because before me was a Sun God with even greater probability than Agni, capable of single-handedly incinerating a planet.」

His arrival here must have meant that Vedas had decided not to stand idly by.

I asked nervously.

【Have you come to fight me?】

No matter how strong I'd become, I wasn't in a position to engage in a full-scale war against a single Giant Nebula.

「Did my calculations go wrong?」

According to information from Moral, the Giant Nebulas in the upper scenarios were all focused on 'Ragnarok', making it unlikely they'd be deployed here. However, I didn't expect them to use such a powerful force to descend, even after Agni.

If I were to fight Surya now, would I be able to win?

While the situation was different from when Kim Dokja fought in the 'Demon King Selection Tournament', with the ability to use the 'Demon King of Salvation' story, the odds weren't completely out of the question.

The problem was buying time to switch modes.

[You've proven yourself sufficiently. I have no intention of continuing this war of attrition.]

Surya's light, which had been weighing on the area, was fading. Did that mean he had no hostility?

【Why are you stopping me?】

[I will take Agni's soul.]

Slowly bending down, Surya picked up Agni's torn soul. Agni's eyes closed and trembling, drooled in his arms.

[Haven't you already received sufficient compensation? Show mercy to this foolish star.]

【What will I gain in return for that mercy?】

If I could take the soul of a 'Lokapala' here, I could use it in some way for a bargain.

Not just any other Constellation, but a soul of the Lokapala class, there would be countless stars drooling.

[I will remember that mercy.]

I stared at Surya for a moment, then asked.

【You? Not <Vedas>?】

[<Vedas> has nothing to do with this.]

As if to prove his point, the probability of <Vedas> no longer seemed to be present in the sky.

[It was my will that brought me here. Agni was once my close friend.]

The light emanating from his entire body testified to the truth of his words.

「Agni is the god of flame. Strictly speaking, the source of that flame was the supreme sun, 'Surya'.」

In a sense, 'Agni' was a kind of mediator, carrying Surya's light to the earth.

Thinking about it, I began to understand why Surya had come here.

【I will remember your oath.】

I slowly withdrew my hand and said. Since Surya had already blocked my path, there was no reason to forcefully seize Agni's soul. After all, I had already defeated Agni and obtained the story.

Surya bowed his head to me in gratitude and said,

[The sun remembers your mercy, great Recorder of the stars.]

A dull horn rang out from the sky, and Surya and Agni's bodies instantly emerged from the scenario. The constellations, watching for an opportunity to intervene in the fleeting events, began to emit bright light.

[Some Constellations are indignant at the 'Supreme God of Light's intrusion into their scenario…]

[Constellations in the smaller Nebulae were surprised by <Veda>'s judgment…]

I looked up at the sky. Unfortunately for the Constellations, this was the end of the stage.

I silently summoned Bihyung, and he appeared in the sky with sparks.

[Now, Constellations. I will briefly check the channel to determine the probability.]

This was my contract with the Management Bureau.

「"When I signal, turn off the channel for a moment."」

When I signaled Bihyung, he promised to turn off the channel for a moment for inspection.

It was a favor I received in exchange for dealing with the Recorders in this area.

—This time, I was genuinely impressed. Perhaps, if it really were you…

The sound of the channel closing was heard along with Bihyung's voice coming through the 'Dokkaebi Communication'.

[Channel operation in this area is temporarily suspended!]

Feeling the starlight fading, I deactivated 'King of Fear' mode. This was to prevent the aftershock of the tilted balance beam after Surya's disappearance.

[The story, 'King of Fear', ceases speaking.]

The Great Hall closed, and my body, deprived of its external powers, plummeted to the ground.

Holding the story of the King of Fear had drained most of my energy, leaving my incarnation body with no energy left to even activate [Way of the Wind].

But...

「There was someone here who wielded [Way of the Wind] better than anyone else.」

A woman ran toward me, calling my name from afar. She, who had inherited the story of the 'Flying Squirrel' from the 'Recycling Center', activated [Way of the Wind] with all her might and rushed towards me.

"...ssi."

Kyung Sein called out, embracing me as I fell through the air.

"Dokja-ssi."

Holding my incarnation body, scorched by the probability, Kyung Sein was calling me Kim Dokja again.

I gently placed my arm around her shoulder, holding back tears, and said,

"I told you. I'm quite strong now."

Jung Heewon, who got up from afar, was looking this way.

We stared at each other for a moment.

Just by exchanging glances, we could tell what each other was thinking.

Jung Heewon was the first to speak.

"You're alive."

I nodded and replied.

"Yes."

Without asking any further questions, Jung Heewon approached silently, leaving me wanting more. There was much to say and hear, but for now, it was time to simply savor this quiet reunion.

The mighty Constellations had vanished, and the once-extinguished sky was brightening again. The long night had passed, and dawn was dawning on the 'New Murim District'.

Even though a Constellation had disappeared tonight, the scenario still continued.

"Let's go see the end of this world together."

Soon, word would spread among the Constellations.

The news that an Outer God who had defeated one of the Locapalas of the Vedas existed in the 70th scenario would spread throughout the Star Stream. The Battle of Agni was merely a prelude to the great war that was about to begin.

[Your story resonates.]

As if to prove that truth, the story pulsing within my heart began to beat violently.

Perhaps, by now, across the sky, that guy is thinking the same thing I am.

[Someone in the higher scenario has noticed your return.]

I smiled, thinking of him.

「So, wait in the ■■ of all these worlds, my brother.」

The 'Final Record' of this worldline will soon begin.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 930 Episode 54 8 years ago (1)

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「So, who exactly is 'Kim Dokja'?」

—Great Dokkaebi Halong.

---

Management Bureau's Korean Peninsula branch.

Bihyung was constantly sweating profusely, bowing his head to his superior on the screen.

—So you're saying you abused your 'probability-appropriate judgment' without even receiving permission from your superiors?

The Great Dokkaebi's voice was sharp. Bihyung calmly responded.

[It was a likely situation. If we had left it as it was, the 'New Murim District' would have been destroyed by the probability aftermath. It was unavoidable for the proper progression of the scenario.]

For the proper progression of the scenario. Could there be a more plausible excuse for a Dokkaebi who was running the scenario?

Great Dokkaebi Halong licked his lips with a disapproving look and said.

—<Veda> will absolutely not tolerate this.

[What can we do if they don't? Even if they are a Giant Nebula, they have no right to interfere with the administration's affairs.]

—It's not that simple, Bihyung.

Of course, Bihyung understood why Halong was troubled.

The Great Dokkaebis are the closest thing to being the 'next Dokkaebi King'.

All their actions are directly linked to their own future glory, and because of this, the vain great dokkaebis often make choices that conflict with each other in the same scenario.

This was the case with the 'New Murim District'.

「Eliminate the 'New Murim District' Recorders.」

「Indifference to the Great Nebula's interference with the scenario.」

The two Great dokkaebis gave conflicting orders, and Bihyung followed the first. This was because it came from his direct superior, the Great Dokkaebi 'Baram'.

As a result, the Great Dokkaebi Halong was somewhat resentful of Bihyung for disobeying his orders.

—Who defeated Agni?

[It's an incarnation called Cheon Inho.]

—Cheon Inho?

Upon hearing the name, Halong pondered something and then asked.

—Could it be that the 'Evil Sophist' was involved?

[No. There's no evidence of direct involvement from a high-level Recorder of Fear.]

But Halong still seemed suspicious.

[As you may know, he's one of the incarnations who used to operate under the name 'Kim Dokja'.]

—There must have been so many of them. Anyway, if someone strong enough to defeat Agni is strong enough to rise to the higher-level scenarios, there's a chance they'll be promoted sooner or later.

[It will be.]

—Watch closely. <Vedas> might contact you again.

[Does this mean <Vedas> will once again throw in probability?]

—Since they lost one of the Lokapala, it's not impossible.

[He defeated Agni according to the scenario's legitimate probability. The Giant Nebulae would no longer have any justification for interfering with the sub-scenarios.]

—What?

[Encouraging newly blooming stories from being trampled by other 'Giant Stories'. Isn't that the duty of our storytellers?]

Bihyung absentmindedly remarked, then was startled by the fact that he had said so himself.

Halong, his eyes narrowing even more, asked back.

—Since when have you been concerned with such things?

[I'm sorry.]

—Just do what you're told. If you keep doing this, you'll be fired.

When did he begin to consider the true nature of a storyteller? He doesn't know. Perhaps it was when he first met him at Geumho Station, or when he saw him scribbling down the story of the ground rats, ignoring both Dokkaebis and Constellations. Or else—

「[Until my last breath, I will speak of you.]」

Perhaps it was because he happened to glimpse a story fragment floating around in the 'Fear Realm'.

「"I wanted to see your story through to the end."」

Bihyung couldn't understand why his voice remained in that story. Why, what, for what reason, and to whom had he spoken?

[Are you alright?]

A spirit with a worried expression approached from behind the disconnected screen. Bihyung shook his head, shaking off his thoughts, and answered.

[It's alright. What can they do up there? This is our responsibility.]

[What about the postponed scenario?]

The main scenario, originally scheduled to proceed, was pushed back due to Agni's excessive probability.

[Resuming in the afternoon.]

The final scenario of 'New Murim District' will soon begin.

Bihyung muttered, peering at the screen on the other side with a confused look.

'I've done enough, you rascal.'

On the screen, a blond man, supporting his colleagues as they walked, suddenly looked back at Bihyung and locked eyes. Knowing it was an illusion, Bihyung held the man's gaze for a long moment, a bitter smile forming on his face.

---

After defeating Agni, we returned straight to the mansion.

"So this was master's residence."

Jung Heewon surveyed the mansion of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint with a mixture of emotions.

All the way back to the mansion, Jung Heewon briefly recounted the events that had transpired. While the story was exactly as I'd read from the records of 'Bicheonhori', hearing it from Jung Heewon's own lips felt new.

"I'm sorry I'm so late. I should have come see you sooner."

"No, Heewon unnie."

Kyung Sein quickly waved off Jung Heewon's apology. Watching their conversation after so long, I, too, felt a strange sense of emotion. Come to think of it, these two have been friends ever since Geumho Station.

Jung Heewon was even Kyung Sein's favorite character while reading.

Eight years ago, that was definitely the case.

"When I first heard the rumors about the Mad Sword Emperor, I thought it might be you."

"…"

"You were busy trying to rescue Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, right?"

From what I heard, Jung Heewon had been working to rescue Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who was imprisoned underground in the 'New Murim District' for the past several months.

"Yes, but ultimately failed."

Is destroying the 'Orbital Elevator' related to that?"

Jung Heewon nodded with a grave expression to my question.

"Yes, that's right."

"But it was too dangerous. The Orbital Elevator…"

Jung Heewon's eyes lit up at my words.

"Does Dokja-ssi know the true nature of the 'Orbital Elevator'?"

"I heard it's a passageway for ascending to a higher scenario."

The chosen ascenders ascend to a higher scenario via the 'Orbital Elevator' when the Ascension Ceremony begins. That, as far as I knew, was the reason for the 'Orbital Elevator's' existence.

"That's a true explanation, but it's not the whole story."

Jung Heewon, after hearing my words, stared at the sky beyond and added,

"The Ascenders have all trained their stories and incarnations to the limit through 'D-Coins'. Their bodies, trained through unnatural means, are practically extremely

condensed 'D-Coins'."

I had a rough idea. That's because I'd heard similar information from Cloud Mountain in the archives.

"The Constellations of the higher scenarios consider the ascenders as 'well-groomed prey'."

"So, all the ascenders who ascended..."

"Not all of them, but I heard that most are captured by 'Giant Nebulae' and have their 'D-Coins' extracted."

It was horrific. In other words, the Ascendants here were nothing more than a sort of intermediary, transporting the condensed 'D-Coins' to the higher-level scenarios.

"So you destroyed the 'Orbital Elevator' on the Ascension Platform?"

"Yes. If we destroy it, the city's attention will be drawn to it. The Constellations in the higher scenarios would naturally focus on restoring the orbital elevator, and I believed I could use that opportunity to rescue the imprisoned Master."

"But it didn't work out."

"Yes."

The reason for Jung Heewon's failure was simple: the Constellations' response was too swift. The moment they recognized Jung Heewon's presence, they immediately mobilized the 'Recorders of Fear', dispatched Agni, one of the Lokapalas, and even unleashed [Fate].

There couldn't have been a more precise and powerful response.

Even if Yoo Joonghyuk had been there, not Jung Heewon, he wouldn't have survived.

"If you hadn't come, I would have died. Thank you again."

Jung Heewon's bow felt strangely unfamiliar, so I smiled awkwardly.

"It took eight years..."

Jung Heewon, who somehow heard those words, raised her head and looked at me silently.

[The story, 'Regret, Exhaustion, Obsession', mutters.]

What kind of story is that?

"I've finished organizing the dorm. You two, please rest inside for a moment."

Namgung Myung emerged from the inner courtyard and guided us to our quarters.

Jung Heewon and I were both exhausted from our confrontation with Agni. It was time to take a break for the next scenario, whether it was by consuming the 'Daehwadan' or the 'Essence of the Elaine Forest'.

[The 'Main Scenario' will resume in 8 hours.]

Just then, a scenario alarm sounded.

We had just finished a tough battle, but it wouldn't give us any time to rest.

[Your wondrous achievements are being spread throughout the <Star Stream>.]

[The Constellations, impressed by your efforts, have donated a total of 24,000 D-Coins to you.]

Soon, the other Great Constellations will learn of Agni's defeat.

<Vedas> had sacrificed a great deal of its fortunes in this incident, so it couldn't intervene again. Nevertheless, there were still many powerful enemies left in this city.

The good news is that whoever the enemy is, we're not alone anymore.

"Before that, first, can I join the company?"

Kyung Sein paused at my words. Then Jung Heewon chimed in.

"Oh, me too."

Kyung Sein looked back and forth between me and Jung Heewon several times, her expression looking as if she might burst into tears at any moment.

"Are you really going to join our company? Both of you?"

Kyung Sein, her eyes wide as lanterns, stammered and asked again. Jung Heewon and I exchanged glances and nodded again.

Kyung Sein looked at us with a complex expression and said,

"But you two would be treated much better if you joined another company."

Her expression seemed happy, sad, and perhaps even worried.

I added, trying to keep her from feeling too burdened.

"I think this is the only company that will accept us now, right?"

"Huh?"

"It seems you've already forgotten who we just beat up."

Kyung Sein's eyes widened faintly at my words.

"I think we should be begging you to accept us, right, Heewon-ssi?"

"Yes. I beg you, Sein-ah."

Kyung Sein bit her lip and lowered her head.

"Even if you two come, I won't be able to help you in any way. Just like back then, and…"

"Sein-ssi."

I interrupted Kyung Sein and lightly placed a hand on her shoulder.

"Thank you for being alive."

My gratitude was sincere.

A reader whose only source of information was reading a single novel had survived through 70 scenarios. I knew better than anyone how difficult that was.

Kyung Sein, who had been staring blankly at me, wiped her eyes and smiled bashfully.

"Everything has changed, but you, Sein-ssi, seem to be the same as you were eight years ago."

I smiled back at Kyung Sein, then suddenly realized something and asked,

"Sein-ssi, but is it okay for you to call me by 'that name'?"

When I met Kyung Sein recently, she called me 'Cheon Inho'.

"I heard from Gungmyung-ssi that saying that name feels uncomfortable."

I glanced at the logo engraved on their backs.

<■■■ Company>

The word that goes in that '■■■' must be 'Kim Dokja'.

If I'm right, Kyung Sein was hesitant to call me by that name for some reason.

"Ah... Myeong-i mentioned it."

Kyung Sein slowly lowered her head and replied.

"That's right. Saying that name isn't easy."

For a moment, her eyes seemed to sparkle with something like pure white snow.

"Every time I say that name, I feel a strange, uneasy feeling inside, should I say... So, I tried not to call that name if possible."

Kyung Sein raised her head again, her eyes clear.

"I don't know why, but ever since you defeated the 'Flame of Purification', I don't mind calling that name anymore."

Since I defeated Agni?

[Your wondrous achievements are widely known in the region.]

[The constellations that praise you await your next move.]

Perhaps it has something to do with the story I built in this scenario.

[The story, 'He Who Witnessed the Truth of the Stars', growls.]

「He Who Witnessed the Truth of the Stars was a quasi-mythical story obtained after defeating Agni.」

Since we have a contract with Bihyeong, I should soon be able to upgrade this story to 'Mythical' level with the help of the Management Bureau.

But before that, there was something I needed to know.

"Sein-ssi, would you please tell us now?"

"Yes?"

"What happened eight years ago?"

"Ah..."

It was time to really listen.

What had happened to Kyung Sein and her companions over the past eight years?

Why were they torn apart, and she was left here alone?

Kyung Sein, who had been hesitating, slowly spoke.

"That's right. It's you, Dokja-ssi, who deserves to know."

Of course, I had a hunch.

Perhaps this story had something to do with why she feared the name 'Kim Dokja'.

"This might be a long story, is that alright?"

"It's alright."

Kyung Sein paused for a few breaths before speaking again.

"Eight years ago, on that day when Dokja-ssi disappeared and the Fear Realm was destroyed..."

But why?

"Someone came to see us."

I'd only heard a few words, but suddenly, it felt as if cold snow was falling all over the world.

Kyung Sein began to speak in a voice that seemed to dream of that day.

"He said he came from the 'Snow Field'."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 931 Episode 54 8 years ago (2)

Five months after the monsters of the 'Fear Realm' appeared in the scenarios.

"We've finally come this far."

Killer King and the readers finally arrived in the 'First Murim'. This was before the 'First Murim' was reborn as the 'New Murim District'.

"The injured, come this way!"

"If you need the 'Essence of the Elaine Forest', follow that man!"

"Okay, the sick, this way!"

The Inho faction at Geumho Station. And even the followers of the 'Beggar Sect' near Seoul Station.

The legacies of Kim Dokja's 41st Round were gradually gathering in the higher-level scenarios.

[The Constellation, 'The Last Ark', is deeply moved by the appearance of the incarnations.]

There, the group also encountered a familiar Constellation.

"Cheongae-nim!"

Cheongae, the Dragon Head Ark of the Beggar Sect. He had been hiding in Murim after suffering a major blow when the Fear Realm appeared, and he had welcomed the group.

"I see. So you're his colleagues?"

Cheongae told the group about what had happened.

How Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk had come to Murim.

How Yoo Joonghyuk, now a child, had eaten Murim dumplings.

How Kim Dokja, after causing numerous troubles, had entered the Fear Realm to protect the First Murim.

Someone was moved to tears upon hearing this story.

"As expected, Dokja-ssi was here. The real 'Kim Dokja'."

Kyung Sein and her group were elated.

Here was the Kim Dokja they remembered.

They had come to the right place.

"So this is the Breaking the Sky Swords Saint."

Finally arriving at the manor where Breaking the Sky Swords Saint resided, the group was overcome with emotion.

They might soon meet Breaking the Sky Swords Saint. Perhaps with her help, they could track Kim Dokja's whereabouts.

"Unfortunately, the lord is out of town."

The one who greeted them was the former head of the Namgung family, Emperor's Sword Namgung Jincheon. After the 'Fear Realm Incident', his energy had deteriorated significantly, so he resigned from his position as head of the family. He had been living in the Breaking the Sky manor, caring for his son, who hadn't awakened for months.

"Where is Breaking the Sky Sword Saint?"

"She entered the Fear Realm with her disciple. Frankly, I'm surprised she had allies other than the Supreme King."

Perhaps due to the shock of the 'Fear Realm Incident', Namgung Jincheon seemed to struggle even with brief conversations with his companions.

Getting additional information from him seemed difficult, and the group's pursuit ran into trouble.

"This is where our plan goes awry."

"If we can't get help from the Transcendents... what should we do?"

"Is there any way for us to enter the Fear Realm alone?"

"Even if we find a way, if we go in alone, we're certain to be annihilated."

Despite their arduous efforts, they couldn't find a way into the closed 'Fear Realm', and so naturally, they settled in the 'First Murim World'.

They tended to the injured martial artists, and occasionally fended off the 'Nameless Things' that crossed dimensions.

"Damn, those guys are out here too."

Perhaps because they were near the 'Fear Realm', the 'Nameless Things' were quite numerous.

But the group wasn't ordinary anymore. After successfully completing the 'Recycling Center', they had each trained themselves in their own ways.

"Ye Hyu-woo! Formation X!"

Under Killer King's command, Ye Hyunwoo's [Armed Fortress] activated.

"Invincible Castle Master Tech Tree. Stage 10 activated."

As the Armed Fortress revealed itself according to the contract with the 'Defense Master', the 'Nameless Things' that had torn through the dimension quickly collapsed into a hive.

"Yerin-ah!"

Cha Yerin followed suit, dispatching the larger entities with a dazzling performance.

"Wow, where did they come from—"

A force so powerful that even the Murim people were amazed.

Even after entering the 'First Murim World', the group continued their training. They mastered new martial arts and explored hidden pieces, the kind Kim Dokja would have found.

「But things didn't go so smoothly.」

This happened when Killer King and Ye Hyunwoo were away to handle Scenario 32 on the Korean Peninsula.

"What is that?"

'It' suddenly appeared in the vast Murim sky. The sky changed color, and the Murim people screamed and bled.

「That was a calamitous fear—an Outer God that Murim would later call the 'Eight-Forked Wandering'.」

A gigantic cephalopod, reminiscent of the 'Dream Eater', wriggled its legs as it crossed the 'Great Hall'.

【Kakakakakakakakakakaka】

Kyung Sein also knew that such monsters often appeared near the Fear Realm.

Cheongae had clearly warned her.

But Kyung Sein trusted herself and her companions. With the group they had now, they could face any enemy. They weren't weak anymore—that's what she clearly thought.

She had thought.

「We can't fight something like that.」

When she came to her senses, Kyung Sein found herself unconsciously taking a step back. Her legs trembled, and a cold sweat ran down her spine. Her mouth—

"IwaswrongIwaswrongIwaswrongIwaswrongIwaswrong—"

She kept repeating the same words.

She looked around and saw that Lee Dansu was in a similar state. Lee Dansu, kneeling and coughing up blood, stammered with a pale face.

"Se, Sein-ssi."

Amidst all this, there was one comrade who remained calm and burning with fighting spirit.

Cha Yerin stumbled out of the manor, blood pouring from her mouth.

"No! Yerin-ssi!"

Cha Yerin had suffered internal injuries from a previous scenario that even the 'Essence of the Elaine Forest' could not heal.

"You can't move yet!"

According to the divine prescription, the wound could only be healed with a 'Sacred Oil' item.

Sacred Oil is a rare item not available in lower-level scenarios.

Killer King, Ye Hyunwoo, and Ji Eunyu were all traveling between different scenarios, executing the constellations' 'personal scenarios', all to obtain the Sacred Oil that would save her.

"It's okay."

Yet, Cha Yerin had revealed herself outside the manor to protect her companions.

"Both Sein-ssi and Dansu ahjussi were injured, right?"

Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu were also seriously injured in the previous scenario. While their injuries weren't as severe as Cha Yerin's, their combat capabilities were significantly impaired, making them equally unable to fight.

"Please take care of my back."

Kyung Sein knew perfectly well when she would make that face, her tone surprisingly calm and her expression serene.

「Cha Yerin has decided to die now.」

Kyung Sein screamed as she watched Cha Yerin leap into the sky, her fists clasped in both hands.

What if Killer King, or Ye Hyunwoo, had been there? Or Ji Eunyu, who was exploring a different scenario area, disagreeing with the group's cautious approach?

No.

Kyung Sein knew. No matter which of them was present, a monster like that couldn't be stopped. The only one who can protect the group from that monster—

「Only one person.」

The giant cephalopod's legs twitched, then struck Cha Yerin's incarnation body with a loud noise. The sound of something exploding was heard, and Kyung Sein sank to the ground.

「At that moment, a pure white flash of wind blew from the sky.」

A warm yet sharp wind.

Kyung Sein knew what that wind was.

「Way of the Wind.」

When she raised her head, she saw the legs of an Outer God pouring out stories from the sky.

【Kaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaah】

A terrible scream. Then someone stood down in front of her while holding the fainted Cha Yerin in their arms.

"Everyone, wake up. Are you just going to collapse in a place like this?"

It was the time she heard that voice. Nevertheless, the moment she heard the voice, she got goosebumps. Because that voice was the voice that Kyung Sein had imagined countless times while listening to a certain story.

"I'll tell you how to attack from now on."

A white coat fluttering in the wind.

Giving a glimpse of that familiar back, Kyung Sein rose from her seat as if possessed.

Someone grabbed her shoulder.

"Kyung Sein."

It was Killer King.

Kyung Sein glanced back and forth between Killer King and the man in front of her, saying,

"Killer King-ssi, could that man—"

She wanted to ask. But even without asking, Kyung Sein had a vague idea of who he was.

As if to confirm this, Killer King nodded with a blank expression and muttered,

"The protagonist has returned."

---

When Kim Dokja first appeared, Kyung Sein didn't believe it.

Even after defeating the Outer God, 'Eight-Forked Wandering', with Kim Dokja's help, Kyung Sein still couldn't trust him.

"Now? That doesn't make sense. He can't be the real Kim Dokja."

Because he said he was 'Kim Dokja'.

"No matter how similar he is to Kim Dokja, he's not that person. Everyone knows that."

At least in this world, the 'Kim Dokja' she knew was someone else.

A person who always smiled with narrowed eyes. A person whose tousled blond hair flowed in the wind, a person who sacrificed himself for the group as if he had several lives left.

A person who always seemed to be looking toward a distant ending unknown to them. A person who, even though right next to them, seemed to exist beyond a thick wall.

「That was the 'Kim Dokja of this world' that Kyung Sein remembered.」

She came all this way to save him, to meet him again.

But here, she met another Kim Dokja.

A face that seemed to be a product of the very word 'Kim Dokja'. A person who appeared with a sorrowful smile, cleared the scenario, and rescued the group.

The moment Kyung Sein saw him, she felt an inexplicable sense of rejection.

That person wasn't Kim Dokja.

"Min Jiwon... No, if Ji Eunyu-ssi was here, she would definitely—"

"Kyung Sein, he's a help to us."

Killer King added in a calm voice.

"Since his appearance, the stagnant scenario sections that had been blocked have begun to clear up."

"I know that. But—"

"That guy is Kim Dokja."

Kyung Sein opened her lips in confusion, watching Killer King calmly pronounce the name 'Kim Dokja'.

"How… Can you say that?"

Kyung Sein, though she rarely showed her emotions, deeply trusted Killer King. It wasn't just because Killer King had read the main story more than anyone else in the group.

Killer King wasn't just someone who read a lot, but someone who felt a love for this story more than anyone else.

He endured life by reading and rereading a single story. In a way, he was a man who infinitely resembled Kim Dokja.

With someone like that, she thought he would naturally recognize the 'real Kim Dokja'. She believed he wouldn't deny the 'Kim Dokja' who had been with them.

"Of all people, how could Killer King—"

Killer King's face darkened. For a moment, information flooded through Kyung Sein's mind.

A thought occurred to her.

「Killer King recently discovered a scenario where he could obtain the 'Sungyu Fruit' with Kim Dokja's help.」

Killer King—Cha Sungwoo—was in a position where he absolutely had to save his younger sister, Cha Yerin. In that situation, regardless of whether that 'Kim Dokja' was real, he would have no choice but to protect him.

Kyung Sein, who had turned her head, spoke again.

"Dansu ahjussi, you too, say something."

At that, Lee Dansu, who had been silently looking down at the floor, raised his head.

"Sein-yang, I believe Inho-ssi is 'Kim Dokja'."

"Right? After all, the real Kim Dokja—"

Kyung Sein's expression brightened.

As expected, Dansu ahjussi was different. He knew who the 'real Kim Dokja' was.

"But that man is definitely 'Kim Dokja'."

"Huh?"

Following Killer King, now Lee Dansu.

Kyung Sein's lips trembled.

She was angry. Shouldn't he have not said something like that to them, let alone anyone else?

But Lee Dansu's expression, raised, was unusually strange.

"Sein-yang, have you ever thought about that?"

Lee Dansu, who always had a pleasant smile, asked in a strangely gloomy voice.

"The Inho-ssi we knew... did he really want to become 'Kim Dokja'?"

For a moment, her heart sank.

"We've cleared every scenario relying on Inho-ssi. We've nearly died countless times, and we've come this far relying on his life."

It was a question she'd never considered.

Did the 'Kim Dokja' she knew really want to become 'Kim Dokja'?

"That friend... we call him 'Kim Dokja' as we please."

Now the group knew.

「"My name is ■■■."」

He resembled Kim Dokja, and like him, he saved them, but his real name wasn't 'Kim Dokja'.

"Perhaps we've been burdening Inho-ssi too much up until now."

A faint breeze blew from outside the manor. A white-faced man they knew well was walking across the manor. His figure, illuminated by the dazzling sunlight, looked like the protagonist, tearing through the pure white space and striding towards them.

Lee Dansu muttered in a feeble voice.

"Perhaps it's time to stop tormenting Inho-ssi."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 932 Episode 54 8 years ago (3)

Immediately after hearing Killer King and Dansu's opinions, Kyung Sein's interactions with the group drastically decreased.

The reason was clear.

Lee Dansu and Killer King had begun working on individual scenarios, following the suggestion of the new 'Kim Dokja'.

"I heard a 'Sungyu Fruit' might open in Scenario Area 37. I'm planning to go there and see."

"Should I come with you?"

"No, Lee Dansu and I decided to go together. You stay here and watch over Yerin."

Perhaps it was out of consideration for Kyung Sein.

Watching Killer King and Lee Dansu depart, Kyung Sein suddenly remembered Ji Eunyu's words.

「"Just because we've read the same story doesn't mean everyone will agree."」

Ji Eunyu had left the group early and begun acting independently. When Kyung Sein asked if she really had to leave, if they couldn't carry out the scenarios together, Ji Eunyu only gave her a vague answer.

「"If you made everyone think the same way, then it wasn't a good story in the first place."」

Kyung Sein often pondered what that meant. Of course, there was no easy answer. She could only speculate that perhaps, Ji Eunyu, as an editor, could see something different from everyone else.

「While everyone else was making their own choices, she was the only one stuck here.」

If she had been an editor, a reader who had read the same book a hundred times, or even someone with a special story— would she have made a different choice?

She pondered it, but couldn't figure it out.

Of course, humans can't truly become strangers.

"Sein-ssi."

She turned around, startled, and Kim Dokja was standing there.

"I'm sorry. It seems I surprised you."

"No."

"May I sit down?"

"Please."

The two sat on a bench in front of the manor and watched the crowds pass by. People moving materials through the alleyways, moving and moving again.

"Move slowly!"

After the outbreak of the Fear Realm, the existing ruling structure of Murim completely collapsed.

The giant trees that formed the axis of Murim died, and the giant breakwaters collapsed.

The incarnations, having lost their center of gravity, scattered and sought out other scenario areas.

Of course, some incarnations still remained in Murim. Those who struggled to rebuild the ruined Murim and reclaim the landscape they remembered.

"Move here! This way!"

Looking at such people, the businessman would often feel a strange sensation. Would all that sweat and toil bring back the Murim they longed for? Even if Murim were to revive, even if countless trees were planted in this world and a forest were to be recreated—would it really be appropriate to call that world a Murim?

"Why have you come?"

"Do you need a particular reason to visit your comrades?"

A person with the same face as the 'Kim Dokja' she remembered. Kyung Sein thought as she looked at the man's face.

Perhaps someone who could get closer to 'others' than anyone else in this world, someone who mercilessly understood 'others' and sometimes used that as a weapon in battle.

Perhaps Kim Dokja had come to her this time to use that weapon.

"What did your companions say?"

Kyung Sein repeated to herself. She didn't know what kind of sweet talk he had given the others, but she would never be fooled. She was firm, as if she were building a [Fourth Wall].

"Did they tell you to try to persuade me because I don't recognize you as Kim Dokja?"

But what Kyung Sein overlooked was that his opponent was more adept at breaking the [Fourth Wall] than anyone else in the world.

"Do you hate me, Sein-ssi?"

Instead of answering, Kyung Sein averted his gaze. I hate you. She wasn't sure if that was the appropriate expression.

"I respect your feelings, Sein-ssi. I'm not Sein-ssi, so I can't fully understand your hostility towards me, but…"

Kim Dokja paused, then looked up at the distant sky.

"Do you like novels?"

"I do."

"Then, shall we talk about them for a moment?"

"No."

"Then you can just listen. Because I like talking."

Kim Dokja grinned and began to tell his story without permission.

"There's a novel I used to like."

Naturally, Kyung Sein knew what it was. Kim Dokja was talking about 'Ways of survival'.

"I don't remember everything clearly anymore, but I definitely liked that novel. I especially admired its protagonist."

Kyung Sein was about to say she knew what it was, but held back and kept her mouth shut.

"The protagonist in that novel regresses time and time again. He lives a hellish life over and over again, simply to see the end of the world."

Why? Even though it was a story she clearly knew, hearing it from Kim Dokja's own mouth, it sounded new. Kim Dokja continued.

"Of course, someone who was an ally in the last Round becomes an enemy in this Round. In some Rounds, all the companions love the protagonist, but in others, they all betray him."

Kyung Sein listened intently, forgetting to respond.

"When I first read that passage, I hated the companions who betrayed the protagonist."

"…"

"It was painful to see my ignorant companions follow someone other than the protagonist. I hated them for protecting the new character who had taken the protagonist's place, without even knowing the protagonist's history or what he had sacrificed for them."

Kyung Sein wondered which Round the Yoo Joonghyuk he had been talking about was, but she realized this conversation wasn't just about the 'Ways of Survival'.

"It's okay if I'm not Sein-ssi's Kim Dokja."

Meeting Kim Dokja's calm eyes, Kyung Sein was speechless.

"If you don't want to call me 'Kim Dokja', then you don't have to. That's your right, Sein-ssi."

Just by meeting his gaze, Kyung Sein felt as if he could read her every thought.

Feeling faintly dizzy, Kyung Sein asked,

"What do you want from me?"

"Sein-ssi, you just need to find the ending you want. I will, too."

"What ending do you desire?"

"For all 'Kim Dokja's' to return to their proper place."

Kyung Sein stared blankly at Kim Dokja. The man had the face of the 'Kim Dokja' she envisioned. For a moment, Kyung Sein felt an inexplicable wavering.

"I don't know where I should return to."

"…"

"Am I Kyung Sein, or someone else? I don't even know what kind of story I'm supposed to tell. I have no idea how the rest of the group is enduring all this."

Kim Dokja listened to her in silence. Sensing the pity hidden in his silence, or perhaps ignoring it, Kyung Sein continued,

"I'm no help anymore. My body is somewhat sturdy, but compared to Hyunsung-ssi, I'm nothing, and compared to my colleagues, I lack talent."

Kyung Sein also trained diligently. Like everyone else, she diligently honed her skills and refined her story.

However, her growth was limited. The character she possessed was initially a secondary character. Her growth potential and talent were meager.

Furthermore, she wasn't chosen by a powerful sponsor like Killer King, Lee Dansu, or Ji Eunyu.

"I'm probably not needed for the 'ending' you want to see."

The moment she said those words, Kyung Sein trembled involuntarily. Her fear of the new 'Kim Dokja' wasn't simply about maintaining loyalty to the 'Kim Dokja' she trusted.

She was scared.

"You don't have to take care of me. I just want to stay here like this. I'll stay here while I wait for the Kim Dokja I want."

That was Kyung Sein's choice. It was the only way for her, who was no better than anyone else, who might soon be discarded from the scenario, to become special.

「Kyung Sein thought this was it.」

She'd worked hard and gotten this far. If the Kim Dokja she'd been waiting for never returned, that was fine.

If she were a character, her ■■ would undoubtedly be here.

"Sein-ssi."

Kim Dokja said, looking at Kyung Sein.

"Let me correct what I said earlier. I understand you a little."

"Do you understand? What?"

Kim Dokja didn't answer. He simply stared at Kyung Sein with slightly sad eyes.

At that silent gaze, Kyung Sein unconsciously let out a sharp voice.

"How can you understand this?"

"I've had similar thoughts as you, Sein-ssi. I've also suffered from the thought that I wasn't of any help to my colleagues and was only a nuisance to the scenario."

Kyung Sein listened blankly.

"There was a time when I hated my colleagues for arbitrarily moving towards a different ending, leaving me behind. I definitely resented them for constantly pushing me back when I wanted to stay here."

"You're Kim Dokja, right?"

"You don't know what kind of Kim Dokja I am, Sein-ssi."

Kyung Sein was speechless for the first time. That was right. She didn't know what kind of Kim Dokja he was. She didn't know if he was the 'Demon King of Salvation', the 'Watcher of Light and Darkness', or the 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband'.

No, perhaps that 'Kim Dokja'—

"I, like you, Sein-ssi, am just one of countless 'Kim Dokja Fragments'."

Kyung Sein paused and asked.

"What does that mean? Could it be that you've possessed someone too?"

"No, I was born with a body. Instead, unlike you, I landed outside the scenarios."

"Outside?"

"Just a vast, endless snowfield stretching out like a vast ocean. I was born and raised there."

A vast, ocean-like snowfield.

Kyung Sein couldn't tell if that was a metaphor or not. She'd never heard of a Kim Dokja like that, nor imagined one.

Nevertheless, his story was certainly true. A small fragment, dormant deep within his soul, testified to that.

"Perhaps, if no one had taken me in, I would have starved to death there, never knowing my own name."

A tragedy told in a frighteningly calm voice.

Kyung Sein felt confused.

"That's where I first met you."

"Us?"

"Snowdrops often fall there."

[NOTE 1]

At some point, dark clouds began to gather in the sky. Rain began to fall lightly. Kim Dokja continued, looking up at the drizzling raindrops.

"Sein-ssi, I know what kind of life you've lived."

"…"

"I know how hard you've worked, how much you've endured to help your colleagues."

"Wait a minute."

Her heart pounded and she felt dizzy.

"Stop it."

「Maybe this person really is Kim Dokja.」

It felt as if someone was forcibly imprinting those words on her mind. She didn't want to think about it. Just thinking about it was painful.

If he really was Kim Dokja, if he was the Kim Dokja they knew—why had he only just appeared before them now?

"I'm sorry."

Kim Dokja was apologizing as if answering that question.

"I was foolish. I should have come here long ago. I should have resolved the scenarios with you myself. Instead of just watching, I should have tried to change the story myself."

Looking at those strangely bright eyes, Kyung Sein felt as if he were about to collapse at any moment.

"It's late, but I intend to change things now."

It was then that thunder rumbled. The sky opened with an unusual gale. A cluster of pure white light flickered. Through it, distant beings descended.

[The Constellation, 'Flame of Purification', descends into this scenario!]

[The Constellation, 'Omnipotent Sun', descends into this scenario!]

[The Constellation, 'Terminator of War', descends into this scenario!]

[The Constellation, 'Monarch of the Small Fries', descends into this scenario!]

Kim Dokja, already standing, stepped forward as if to protect her.

"Uninvited guests have arrived."

Constellations. And these were no ordinary Constellations. A sinister aura enveloped the vast sky. These Constellations were at least as powerful as Narrative-grade, and even rivaled the main force of the Giant Nebulae.

Kyung Sein instinctively sensed this.

Those Constellations hadn't appeared here out of favor.

[Are there frag ments of the Old est Dream here?]

Kim Dokja smiled at the Constellations' call.

"It seems they've come to find me."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Can be both snowdrops and story fragments.

# 933 Episode 54 8 years ago (4)

Kyung Sein grabbed Kim Dokja's sleeve like a madman.

"Dokja-ssi."

Forgetting that she had unconsciously called the man 'Kim Dokja', Kyung Sein hurriedly pulled Kim Dokja's sleeve.

"We have to run."

The Constellations hadn't discovered them yet. It wasn't too late to run. Whether using [Way of the Wind] or purchasing a scenario escape ticket from the 'Dokkaebi Bag', they had to escape from here. Otherwise—

"No, Sein-ssi."

Kim Dokja's gaze was fixed on the manor. Cha Yerin was there, currently recuperating.

Kim Dokja knew. If he left this place, those Constellations would take their companions hostage.

"Please call the other companions."

Kim Dokja's words seemed to fly into her heart anew.

「Comrades.」

Kim Dokja, before him, truly considered them companions.

"You?"

"I'll buy you some time."

Kim Dokja's back was small as he turned. Just as Kyung Sein had once read, his slender torso swayed as if ready to break in the gust of wind. Watching his back sway as if ready to break in the wind, Kyung Sein realized something.

「Even if I call my companions, there's no way we can deal with those Constellations.」

The Constellations of <Vedas>, <Olympus>, <Isgard>, and <Tamra> were there.

[A Giant Nebula is supporting the probability of the Constellations.]

The <First Murim> was a 20th-level scenario area. A place where the original Constellations could never descend.

Those Constellations were revealing their true colors in a lower-level scenario, enduring enormous losses.

Each and every one of them reached the level of late-stage Narrative-grade. If just one of them unleashed their full power, the party would be annihilated without a trace.

Kim Dokja was advancing, determined to confront these Constellations alone. Under the pretext of calling their comrades, he gave Kyung Sein an excuse to escape, and he continued on alone.

「Just like the day he first became the 'Oldest Dream'.」

The 'Kim Dokja' he truly wanted to protect wasn't the Kim Dokja before her. Yet, he was undoubtedly Kim Dokja.

"I can't leave you alone."

Kim Dokja slowly turned his head and glanced at Kyung Sein. His eyes were slightly surprised.

"If you're Kim Dokja, then I'm Kim Dokja too."

Kim Dokja's head slowly moved at Kyung Sein's words.

"If that's so, then so be it."

Kim Dokja smiled brightly.

"Instead, whatever you see from now on, don't be surprised."

Before she could even ask what that meant, the Constellations in the sky twinkled for a moment.

[Were you there?]

He took a deep breath, and four Constellations appeared before his eyes.

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

Four brightly shining stars. When the Constellations, who should never have descended into a lower scenario, simultaneously revealed their powers, all incarnations were plunged into a state of near-death.

The incarnations of Murim, just beginning to rebuild, collapsed to the ground, groaning. Some were even gasping for breath, foaming at the mouth.

The unconscious incarnations might have been fortunate. The moment they unleashed their immense power, Kyung Sein felt as if she were about to lose her mind.

"Ah. Aah. Aaaah..."

Kyung Sein collapsed, groaning, unable to overcome her fear.

The Constellations glanced at her as if she were an insect, then turned to Kim Dokja.

[Fragment of the Oldest Dream. Why did you break your promise?]

As the omnipotent sun Apollo uttered these words, the other Constellations, as if they had been waiting, began to speak.

[There was no mention of you directly interfering with the scenario, was there?]

[What brought you here? Have you forgotten our promise?]

With each successive mantra, blood flowed from Kyung Sein's ears. Her head ached as if it were going to split open. Her entire body trembled incessantly.

They were on a different level. She couldn't believe she had to fight against such things to see the scenario's conclusion.

Yet, as if he wasn't afraid of such Constellations, Kim Dokja smiled and spoke.

"Let's skip unnecessary conversation. You didn't come here just to protest, did you?"

Perhaps it was the subtle condescension in his tone that caused the Constellations' expressions to change.

[What did you just say?]

"You came to covet me, didn't you?"

[What did you say?]

"There's no need to try to deny it. I paid a price to descend here, so you must have thought this was your chance. Don't you?"

Kyung Sein listened blankly to Kim Dokja's words. At that moment, Kim Dokja no longer seemed like the 'Kim Dokja' she knew from the story.

"Are you going to deny that you came to thrust those ugly teeth at me?"

Kim Dokja slowly walked. One step, then two. Each time he approached the Constellations, their shoulders trembled in shock.

"I have no regrets. After all, we received everything from the <Star Stream>. So, it would be right to return it to the <Star Stream>."

For a moment, the surrounding scenery seemed to change. An icy wind blew from somewhere.

Kim Dokja was walking alone along the lonely path in the Snowfield.

[The story, 'Messiah of the Snowfield', begins its storytelling.]

Kyung Sein and the other Constellations stared at him, as if entranced.

「All the stars in the world were shining down on him.」

At that moment, Kim Dokja's coat fell to the floor. His tie followed, and then his dress shirt. With every step he took, Kim Dokja's clothes fell to the floor.

The Constellations watched him, holding their breath. Kim Dokja, now stripped of even his shoes, stood before the Constellations. His naked body was exposed to the sunlight.

The moment she saw that white back, Kyung Sein was thrown into confusion. While clearly a human body, Kim Dokja's body didn't feel human at all. No, it wasn't flesh in the first place. In other words, it was—

「A story about a story. A myth about a myth.」

Kim Dokja, shining brightly in the starlight, was there.

Apollo, the Omnipotent Sun, Vidar, the End of War, and the Master of Baekrokdam were all kneeling.

A single image formed on their empty retinas.

The single being that filled their universe commanded:

"Take whatever you wish."

The moment permission was granted, the Constellations rose from their seats.

Apollo was the first to move. A harsh mantra burst from his lips.

[M-my— I— What I'm going to do— that's right—]

His eyes, which had been struggling to reject the legend in front of him, slowly began to turn red. His out-of-focus pupils shook, and a wild beast-like noise came out of his mouth.

[Geuaaaaa!]

Slamming down on all fours like a beast, Apollo mawed at Kim Dokja. Like a lover clutching their beloved, Apollo seized Kim Dokja’s shoulders with trembling hands and buried his teeth into him.

As blood-colored stories erupted, the other two gods sprang to their feet.

[OhOhOhOhOh!]

A primal hunger, utterly devoid of dignity or honor, consumed them. The flickering stars wept as they panted. There were no 'Twelve Gods of Olympus,' no 'Lokapala,' no 'myth-grade constellations.'

Only sick, ravenous stars, craving the story before them, remained.

Apollo savagely gouged into Kim Dokja's shoulder, Vidar ripped at his arm, and the Master of Baengnokdam stooped to bite his ankle.

[Oooooooo—]

A single story pierced their souls.

A story that violently overwhelmed the soul of the reader.

A story dominated their souls.

As if he admired such Constellations, Kim Dokja smiled and offered his flesh.

And then, until the very end, he gazed upon the one Constellation that resisted his story.

"Agni. Come closer."

The only Constellation that had not torn his flesh, Agni, the 'Flame of Purification', was there.

Agni, who had set fire to his entire body and burned himself, resisted his own desires with bloodshot eyes.

[I am, the great, Lokapala.]

A story spilled from his pale, trembling lips. Agni, who had struck his own head with an axe, roared and declared,

[I, will not eat.]

Finally, Agni, still holding onto his pride, let out a sorrowful howl and fled the scenario.

Kim Dokja stared silently at the spot where Agni had disappeared.

The other three Constellations, startled, knelt as if in apology.

[I apologize, 'Oldest Dream'.]

Kim Dokja spoke to the Constellations, who had prostrated themselves as if worshipping a god.

"No."

Then, looking up at the sky with an expression of unwavering calm, he added,

"Eventually, <Vedas> will come."

[It will.]

Kyung Sein was confused. She couldn't comprehend the scene unfolding before her eyes.

Why did Kim Dokja speak like that? Why had he given his body to the Constellations? She couldn't understand. She couldn't understand anything. However, one thing was certain: the moment Kyung Sein laid eyes on Kim Dokja's naked body, a terrible thought gripped her.

「I want to become one.」

Even though she knew it was a thought worthy of Nirvana, Kyung Sein couldn't stop it the moment she laid eyes on Kim Dokja.

The thought finally stopped after Kim Dokja picked up the clothes that had fallen on the floor and put them on.

"I have entrusted my blood and flesh to you, so one day I will come back to find myself."

The Constellations bowed their heads in embarrassment at Kim Dokja's words.

Looking down at the crowns of the Constellations, Kim Dokja continued,

"It will be a long road. It may be a road that will never end. But like my brother, I too will walk that road. And thus, I will complete the ■■ of this worldline."

The Constellations sighed. The three Constellations answered simultaneously.

[I will illuminate your footsteps.]

"Until I reclaim myself, what I have given you is yours. In exchange—"

A piercing light flashed in Kim Dokja's eyes. Reflecting the light of the Constellations, it warned them.

"You will rebuild this ruined city."

The divine command fell, and the Constellations, raising their heads, trembled.

"In the fertile land of fear, coins made of my blood will spring forth."

The Constellations, obeying that command, howled simultaneously. A bright light erupted from their bodies. The Constellations' omens moved according to the covenant.

「The blessings of the stars will bloom and scatter over the city. And so, with the blood and flesh of dreams, the reconstruction of a new heaven and a new earth will begin.」

As the Constellations of <Olympus>, <Asgard>, and <Tamra> illuminated the entire city, the dying trees began to rise again.

It began to regain its vitality.

Kim Dokja continued,

"You will prosper the city until my brother arrives here. Thus, you will prepare the final story of the <Star Stream>."

「This place will become a forest of fear. It will become a cradle where the flesh and blood of dreams will be gathered to create a single god.」

Growing trees formed a forest. Above the ruined Murim, structures symbolizing each Constellation rose like the Tower of Babel.

Kim Dokja and the Constellations gazed upon the new city for a long time.

The incarnations, filled with joy and emotion, gathered before the Constellations' structures.

Apollo, seeing this, smiled with satisfaction and opened his mouth.

[The humble servant of the story asks the name of this land.]

Kim Dokja answered,

"From now on, this place will be called the 'New Murim District'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 934 Episode 54 8 years ago (5)

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That was the end of Kyung Sein's story.

During the conversation, a strong spark began to flow through Kyung Sein's body, and after spouting a sermon, she fainted. Just telling this story seemed to have taken a heavy toll on her incarnation body.

Jung Heewon and I laid Kyung Sein down on the bed and watched the white shards of serpentine hovering above her head.

"Will she be okay?"

"She'll be okay."

Kyung Sein groaned, as if having a nightmare. Jung Heewon gently placed a hand on Kyung Sein's forehead and asked.

"Even if I hear it, I don't understand. Are you saying another Dokja-ssi appeared besides Dokja-ssi?"

"..."

"And that Dokja-ssi was devoured by the Constellations... What on earth is that all about?"

Jung Heewon must have had a hard time understanding it.

I shook my head vaguely and answered.

"I'm not entirely sure."

My mind was in turmoil.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja has fully intervened in the 'Scenario'.」

The Kim Dokja I'd first met.

The Kim Dokja who always waited for me in the Snowfield, who visited me countless times in my dreams. The Kim Dokja who enjoyed drinking tea and often wore a sad smile—the Kim Dokja who had been raised by the 'Evil Sophist' and tore apart his brothers—had appeared in the 41st Round.

「He voluntarily gave his story to the Constellations.」

I had some idea why he'd gone to such lengths.

According to the story I'd previously read in Goo Seonah's memories, Snowfield Kim Dokja was a being strong enough to subdue his other brothers by force.

Kim Dokja was a being of such a caliber that even Mythical Constellations couldn't treat him lightly.

If such a powerful being had manifested in the scenario, there should have been a backlash of probability.

But there was no backlash.

「"After all, we received everything from the <Star Stream>. So, it would be right to return it to the <Star Stream>."」

Perhaps he offset the backlash of probability by giving his flesh to the Constellations.

Come to think of it, Cheongae, the Dragon's Head Ark of the Beggar Sect, had made a similar choice. He had lowered his status, participated in a lower-level scenario, and become the laughing stock of other Constellations.

Though the circumstances were different, it would make sense if Snowfield Kim Dokja had made a similar choice.

The question was why he made such a choice.

「Why did the Constellations transform after consuming Kim Dokja's flesh and blood?」

「If Snowfield Kim Dokja truly treated my party as comrades, why did Kyung Sein remain here?」

Complex questions surged through my mind like a tidal wave, then vanished.

For now, only one thing was certain.

「"You will prosper the city until my brother arrives here."」

This city was probably built to await 'me'.

Perhaps Snowfield Kim Dokja rebuilt this city, knowing I would one day return from the Fear Realm.

"Dokja-ssi."

I raised my head and saw Jung Heewon looking at me with a slightly tense look.

I nodded slightly and stood up. I had many questions, but this was not the time to rack my brain.

[The 'Main Scenario' will begin soon.]

The main scenario of the 'New Murim District' was finally about to begin.

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"The original main scenario of the Fear Realm was 'Ascension Ceremony'."

Namgung Myung gave us a brief briefing on the main scenario of the existing 'New Murim District'.

According to Namgung Myung's explanation, the main scenario of the 'New Murim District' was originally 'Ascension'.

"Collecting D-Coins for Ascension, joining a company, and achieving a certain level of rank were the original 'main scenarios' of this area."

Here, incarnations who received support from their company and achieved a high rank became 'ascended beings' and left the city via an 'Orbital Elevator'.

This was the main scenario of the 'New Murim District,' which was inspired by the Fayer light line (the 'Ascension Ceremony') of Murim.

"Fayer light line."

A martial arts myth in which an ordinary person attains enlightenment through long practice and becomes a sage.

A question suddenly occurred to me.

What does it mean for an ordinary person to become a sage?

「To abandon the five desires and seven emotions of humanity and attain divine status, reborn as a new being.」

Kim Dokja, who had given his body to the Constellations, gazed at the city with alien eyes.

Perhaps that's what he wanted from me...

"Even if you ascend to a higher level through the Ascension Ceremony, you can't become like the Constellations you dream of."

My thoughts were interrupted by Jung Heewon, who had been silently listening to Namgung Myung.

"All ascended to higher scenarios become prey to the constellations. The D-coins collected here are offered directly to the constellations."

Namgung Myung, wide-eyed at Jung Heewon's explanation, asked.

"Then why did the Mad Sword Emperor destroy the 'Orbital Elevator'?"

"Because someone had to break that chain."

I thought of the shattered 'Orbital Elevator'.

That day, inside the elevator that crashed into the Ascension Platform, the severed heads of ascended beings and a single message were left behind.

"No one can escape this city."

Perhaps Jung Heewon wanted to frighten the incarnations to prevent further casualties.

Perhaps sensing my gaze, Jung Heewon added in a slightly darkened voice.

"I didn't intend to kill the ascended. I only intended to destroy the 'Orbital Elevator', but the Constellations possessed their bodies and appeared..."

I had a rough idea of the situation. I decided to ask something I'd always wondered about.

"Where did you get that information, Heewon-ssi?"

I'd been curious ever since I first heard Jung Heewon's story.

The secrets of the 'Orbital Elevator' and the 'New Murim District' weren't information an ordinary incarnation could know.

Perhaps Jung Heewon had a Recorder like 'Cloud Mountain' or 'Moral'?

"There's a Constellation that's been helping me since my master was imprisoned."

Constellation?

"Is it perhaps the 'Demon-like Judge of Fire'?"

Jung Heewon shook her head.

I had naturally expected it to be Uriel, but it was a surprise.

Jung Heewon hesitated for a moment, then carefully scanned the sky above and answered.

"The Constellation that helped me is the 'God of Wine and Ecstasy'."

Dionysus, the God of Wine and Ecstasy.

Come to think of it, he had supported Jung Heewon even when she used [Time of Judgment]. I was about to ask how she had come into contact with him, but Namgung Myung spoke in a somewhat agitated voice.

"Benefactor, perhaps now is your chance."

"Yes?"

"A chance to change Murim."

Upon closer inspection, Namgung Myung's expression was strangely excited. The moment I met his expression, I sensed a deeply repressed emotion within him.

In other regions, this emotion might have had many different names, but at least in this Murim it had a set name.

「Consciousness.」

The oldest emotion that drives this Murim.

"If what the Mad Sword Emperor said is true, the other incarnations will certainly not remain silent."

Was the Namgung family's bloodline truly different?

The moment he heard Jung Heewon's story, he seemed to dream of revolution.

"Many incarnations are dissatisfied with the corporate system of control. The reason they haven't rebelled is because they believed anyone could 'ascend' if they tried."

Anyone can ascend to heaven with effort and become as powerful as a Constellation.

The only ladder passed down to the weak, the incarnations. As long as that ladder remains unbroken, the incarnations' desires will be focused on one thing.

But that ladder was recently shattered by the Mad Sword Emperor.

"If the martial artists who have discovered the secrets of the scenario join forces, perhaps we can restore the old Murim. We might be able to return to the days when justice and chivalry were known."

In my opinion, the old Murim wasn't such a good place.

But I also understood what he meant by 'romance'. At least back then, there were people who pondered what chivalry meant, what humanity meant, and what this forest they inhabited was all about.

Kugugugu.

Dark clouds gathered once again in the gloomy sky. I could feel the aftershock of probability drifting through the air.

[The main scenario is delayed.]

It was an ominous omen. Nothing good has ever happened because the main scenario was delayed.

[Someone has invoked 'Fate' upon you.]

As expected.

I smiled bitterly and surveyed the possibilities surrounding me.

It must be the work of <Vedas>.

Those guys who lost Lokapala Agni to me were plotting revenge against me once again through [Fate].

「Kim Dokja of the 'New Murim District' will lose his 'precious thing'.」

The message of [Fate] then rang out.

But even after confirming the message, I wasn't flustered or shaken.

[The story, 'One Who Rewrites Fate', growls.]

I've already faced [Fate] before, and I know how to destroy it.

So [Fate] isn't scary.

In fact, what's important is the stage where [fate] will be written.

[A new main scenario has arrived!]

We immediately checked the scenario contents.

[The 'Tourism Altar' will open soon.]

Tourism Altar?

**<Main Scenario #70 — Tourism>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: S

Clear Conditions: Offer 30 or more 'Tributes' to the 'Altar' located in the center of the 'New Murim District'.

Time Limit: ???

Reward: 50,000 D-Coins, access to the higher-level scenario.

Failure: —

Offer 'Tributes'?

This was a scenario we'd never seen before. The strange thing was that it said to offer 'Tributes', but didn't actually tell us how to obtain them.

Wait a minute. This...

[You can now see the list of 'Tribute Holders'.]

I checked the list, feeling ominous.

**<List of Tribute Holders>**

King of Fear — 100

Mad Sword Emperor — 40

Salvation Cult Leader Nirvana — 35

Blood Jade Fist Demon Jo Jincheol — 20

Paradise Lord Reinheit — 20

The method of obtaining tribute in the 'New Murim District' was simple.

「Hunting other incarnations who already possessed 'Tributes'.」

Namgung Myung sighed, and Jung Heewon frowned.

I said.

"It seems the Constellations have taken the initiative."

There was no way such a scenario could have come down so timely.

Perhaps this was due to the influence of the 'Giant Nebulae' on the Management Bureau.

[A large temporary channel will open soon.]

And the Management Bureau judged this scenario 'likely to pique the interest of the constellations'.

[Many Constellations are waiting to enter the channel.]

Soon, the 'New Murim District' will become an arena for incarnations fighting for tribute.

Jung Heewon said nervously.

"They'll be coming soon."

The 'King of Fear' and 'Mad Sword Emperor' on the list likely refer to me and Jung Heewon.

In fact, the following message had been flashing before my eyes for a while now.

[You currently have '100' tributes.]

[An altar will appear in the central area of the 'New Murim District' in three hours.]

[If you deposit tributes into the altar, you can proceed directly to the next scenario.]

I had already acquired all the tributes needed for the 'route'. I could have completed the scenario by simply waiting three hours and arriving at the altar.

The other incarnations will likely flock here to hunt me and Jung Heewon.

"The incarnations won't come."

But Namgung Myung's thoughts seemed a little different.

"Why do you think so?"

"The benefactor's skills are probably already widely known among the incarnations."

Now that I think about it, Jung Heewon and I had defeated Agni, the 'Flame of Purification', the great Lokapala of Veda. Having witnessed Agni's miserable fate, no incarnation with any common sense would target us.

"They'll choose a much safer method."

"Killing each other?"

"That's one option, but I doubt members of the same company would readily commit murder. Rather, they'd hunt a target they deemed relatively safe and possessing a large amount of tribute, as a group."

A target possessing a large amount of tribute and being relatively safe?

Does such a being exist in this Murim?

"Dokja-ssi."

My eyes met Jung Heewon's at that moment, and an eerie premonition flashed through my mind.

[The incarnation with the 'largest tribute' will soon be revealed.]

The Constellations in the sky twinkled as if mocking me.

Perhaps I wasn't the primary target of this scenario from the beginning.

「A person who pondered what a chivalrous spirit is, what humanity is, and what this forest they inhabit is.」

A loud explosion, like a building collapsing, was heard from afar.

[The incarnation with the largest 'tribute' in the 'New Murim District' is...]

A moment later, the list updated before my eyes.

| |
|---|
| Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung — 500 |

As if we had agreed in advance, we ran out of the garden at the same time.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 935 Episode 55 Giant Tree (1)

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「Even without a forest, trees grow. No matter how much they grow, no one would call them forests.」

—Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyeong.

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Leaving Kyung Sein in Namgung Myung's care, we raced through the streets of the 'New Murim District'.

We saw incarnations engaged in fierce battles all over the Blue Dragon Castle.

"There! Chase them!"

The martial artists were chasing the incarnations listed on the 'Tribute Holders List'.

"No! Not me!"

"Kwaaaaak!"

"That guy just stole my tribute!"

The 'New Murim District' was in utter chaos.

[Many Constellations rejoice in the struggle of the incarnations.]

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', shakes his head in disappointment.]

[The Constellation, 'Emperor of Power', rejoices at the vibrant energy of Murim for the first time in a while.]

Constellations, appearing from nowhere, watched the entire scene.

「Even though we'd reached the 70th scenario, the scenery before our eyes was no different from the subway in the first scenario.」

To survive, to ascend to a higher scenario, they harmed one another. They killed those who had once been comrades, and those who had been indebted to them. They plundered those who greeted them with a smile, and stabbed those they respected in the back.

"Aaaaah! Don't chase me! I told you not to come!"

Among them, there was a familiar face.

The man who had judged me when I first entered the 'New Murim District'.

I think he was called 'Jeon Yeongwoo', a second-class examiner.

[An incarnation with five tributes is approaching.]

He, too, seemed to be an incarnation on the 'List of Tribute Holders'.

"Kill him!"

The examiner, an arrow pierced through his thigh, hurriedly took a step forward and fell to the ground. A magical arrow, imbued with magic, took advantage of the opportunity to strike.

"Eek!"

The examiner hurriedly protected his head and ducked.

Kagagang!

The arrow deflected off my sword. The incarnations, who had spotted me from afar, stopped in their tracks, wary.

I extended my hand to the fallen examiner and asked.

"Are you alright?"

"Well, you…"

I had received a small favor from him before. Of course, his intention was to sell me out to another company, but he had clearly been kind to me, a newbie.

"There! There's a human with 100 tributes here!"

Instead of grabbing my hand, the examiner pointed at me and shouted. Then he got up and limped away.

I watched his back for a moment.

「Perhaps the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint has seen this kind of 'forest' for a long time.」

Those who, to protect their own roots, would not hesitate to kill the roots of other trees.

The place where the roots of such trees intertwined was Murim, where the law of the strong reigned supreme.

"Wait, 100 tributes?"

The incarnations, who had belatedly discovered me, approached me hesitantly.

"There's another one for 40 next to him."

"That person—"

Jung Heewon, standing beside me, sighed softly and pulled out her broken skull mask.

A belated roar of shock echoed.

"Oh my God, it's the Mad Sword Emperor!"

"Haaaaaa!"

"The Slayer of the Ascenders!"

Before Jung Heewon could even begin to assert herself, the incarnations all turned their backs and began to flee. Jung Heewon shook her head, looking at the incarnations, then

added,

"You're still the same, Dokja-ssi."

"What do you mean?"

"You trust people too easily. From now on, be careful who you reach out to."

Jung Heewon looked at my hand, which was wandering in the empty air, and said,

"Not everyone in this world deserves to be saved. Sometimes, it seems like you, Dokja-ssi, want to save everyone."

Not everyone deserves to be saved. I couldn't understand how Jung Heewon had arrived at that answer. However, her answer made me feel a little sad.

「The incarnations who have proven their worth through long scenarios have gathered here.」

The incarnations who proved their worth in the first scenario and finally reached scenario number 70.

Clearly, both they and we struggled to survive and made it this far.

「What did we prove back then to survive?」

Did we even prove something in the first place?

And what did my brother want me to see and feel here?

Kugugugu!

Explosions continued throughout the city.

There were about five locations where the explosions were coming from.

Probably the headquarters of the company.

I turned to Jung Heewon and asked.

"Do you happen to know where Breaking the Sky Sword Saint is imprisoned?"

"I only know that it's in the basement of a certain company."

Jung Heewon had been exploring the 'New Murim District' to rescue Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. However, even she seemed unable to pinpoint the exact location of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's imprisonment.

I recalled the list of companies currently representing the 'New Murim District'.

If they were capable of imprisoning someone as powerful as Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, it had to be one of them.

"There are Constellations that faced you back then."

Jung Heewon recalled her memories.

"Agni, the Purifying Flame. Apollo, the Almighty Sun. Vidar, the Ender of War."

Agni of Veda, Apollo of Olympus, and even Vidar of Asgard. Coincidentally, they were all Constellations that descended here to meet 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

What's unusual is that Asgard, to which Vidar belonged, didn't have any subcontractors here.

"The owner of Baekrokdam."

A beastman of Baek Toknam, a Constellation affiliated with Tamra. As expected, it was the one who ate the stories of 'Kim Nokja of the Snowfield'.

Of course, not all Constellations were like this.

"The White Flame Dragon of Sighs."

One Constellation was presumed to belong to the Black Cloud. And—

"There was also a guy called the 'Drinking Demon'."

A Drinking Demon.

It never appears in the main story, but if I recall correctly, it was a Constellation affiliated with the White Cloud.

"One of those Constellations must be the culprit."

"It's not the White Cloud or Black Cloud Foundation. I've already thoroughly investigated those areas."

I glanced at each location where explosions were coming from.

The area where the explosion was heard was limited, so visiting them all in order would be a viable option.

But right now, I was marked with [Fate]. If I chose the wrong path, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint could be the first to be attacked by the ascended heavens.

I looked up into the void and spoke in my head.

'Unchanging One, are you listening?'

Unchanging One.

It was the Recorder I had met when entering the 'Record Archives' a while ago.

He was originally a Recorder who wrote the records of <Vedas>, but now, through a contract with me, he had become my 'Assistant Recorder'.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', answers your call.]

He seemed to be listening, and he immediately responded.

I picked out a few questions that needed to be answered immediately and asked him.

'Do you know who the guys who put [Fate] on me are?'

The 'Unchanging One' seemed to hesitate for a moment, then quickly answered with a sentence in the air.

「The Afterglow Library.」

The Afterglow Library?

「A record group formed by low-level Recorders.」

「Like the 'Black Book Society', they participated in the 'Fate Record' of the Demon King of Salvation.」

Judging by the description, they seem to be similar to the 'Recorder Group' who stopped me last time.

In that case, there's no need to hesitate any longer.

'I will rewrite [Fate] now.'

Confronting the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint while holding [Fate] was risky, so I immediately unleashed the power of the Recorder. But...

Tsutsutsutsu!

The moment I touched the [Fate] they had written, a strong spark enveloped my hand.

The repulsive force was incomparable to the previous time I modified [Fate].

It was strange. Surely, this was a [Fate] bestowed by the 'lower-level Recorders'?

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One,' says modifying fate is not recommended.]

'Why?'

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One,' says that fates with inaccurate definitions and weak enforcement are sometimes difficult to modify.]

I reviewed the sentence of the [fate] I had received.

「Kim Dokja of the 'New Murim District' will lose his 'precious thing'.」

As the 'Unchanging One' had said, this [Fate] contained points of interpretive uncertainty.

「One, can you clearly identify me as the target of that [Fate]?」

I am called Kim Dokja by people, but in reality, the body I possessed was not 'Kim Dokja'.

So, is this [Fate] truly targeting me?

「Two, what exactly is the standard for 'precious things'?」

「Fate hadn't even properly defined whether 'precious things' were people, objects, or something conceptual.」

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One,' says this 'Fate' doesn't need any revision.]

I understood what he was saying.

「Fate, with its uncertain definition, was difficult to revise, but there was a way to circumvent it.」

That's probably what the 'Unchanging One' wanted to say.

I nodded and asked a second question.

'Do you by any chance know about the confined area of Breaking the Sword Sword Saint?'

He seemed to have prepared an answer, as the sentence immediately came to mind.

「It's highly likely he's imprisoned in the basement of <Olympus Technology> or <Tamra Heavy Industries>.」

「Both companies have underground prisons that imprison 'Fear'.」

It's a shame the locations of <Olympus Technology> and <Tamra Heavy Industries> weren't clearly specified, but the fact that the options were narrowed down to two was a significant gain.

'Good. Wait until I call again.'

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', serves your command.]

I quickly relayed the information I'd discovered to Jung Heewon.

Jung Heewon seemed surprised at how I'd figured it out, but instead of asking, she said,

"<Olympus Technology> is west of Blue Dragon Castle. <Tamra Heavy Industries> is southeast."

There were two options. Ultimately, we had to choose one.

But unfortunately, before we could choose, there were those who had chosen us first.

"Is that the Mad Sword Emperor?"

"Strike! We'll go first!"

They were the ascendants and incarnations of each company.

"Gungmyung-ssi, things are going differently than you expected."

Namsung Myung said the martial artists would avoid us after seeing our prowess. But it seems not everyone was like that.

"There's no way those guys could have defeated Agni!"

"Even if that's true, they're injured. If we all fight together, there's nothing to fear!"

The incarnations of the companies surged forward, their voices roaring. It was a truly immense crowd, hundreds of feet in all.

Perhaps behind them were the incarnations who instigated this.

I kept a close eye on the five ascended beings leading the incarnations at the rear of the group.

Jung Heewon, who had been observing the situation, drew her sword and said,

"Dokja-ssi, go first. I'll follow soon. I can handle those guys on my own."

The moment I saw Jung Heewon's back, a message of fate echoed in my head.

「Kim Dokja of the 'New Murim District' will lose his 'precious thing'.」

I shook my head and stood beside her.

"No, we'll move together this time."

"Even if we don't—"

"I know you're not yet in a position to fight properly."

Jung Heewon was strong. However, her injuries from her battle with Agni hadn't fully healed. Furthermore, if her opponents were ascended beings, and with so many of them, her chances of winning were slim.

"The same goes for you, Dokja-ssi."

Jung Heewon also had a clear understanding of my condition. In reality, I wasn't in a position to unleash the same powerful attacks I'd unleashed against Agni.

I'd already used 'King of Fear' mode once, so I couldn't use it for the time being. I could still use 'Demon King of Salvation' mode, but I had to conserve it.

If I exhausted all my strength here, I wouldn't be able to save the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"So, we should move together."

"Yes?"

"Follow me."

I grabbed Jung Heewon's arm and started running.

"Where are we going? This way…"

My running direction wasn't west, where <Olympus Technology> was, or southeast, where <Tamra Middle School> was.

"Whether we go west or southeast, there will be even more incarnations waiting for us. No matter how strong we become, we can't face the entire Murim."

"So you have some kind of plan?"

"Heewon-ssi, why do you think they're chasing us?"

Jung Heewon thought for a moment and answered.

"Isn't it because of the tributes?"

The tributes. The core of this 'scenario', the sacrifices necessary for ascension.

I smiled faintly and answered.

"We have a total of 140 tributes. And the 'altar' ritual requires 30."

"Huh...?"

"Isn't that strange? Even if they take all our tributes, only four incarnations can ascend. That means they can't all ascend."

"Then why are they...?"

No sooner had she finished asking than the Ascendant's question came from the back of the line.

"I will award 3,000 D-Coins to the first one to take the head of the Mad Sword Emperor!"

The incarnations, emboldened by the ascendant's declaration, accelerated and began to pursue us.

Jung Heewon, realizing something belatedly, spoke.

"Couldn't—"

"That's right."

The given 'tribute' is limited, and not everyone can ascend through this main scenario.

No, not everyone wanted 'ascension' in the first place. Even if you become stronger and advance to a higher scenario, you'll only end up as the tail of a dragon at best.

There are those in this city who have given up on ascending, declaring themselves masters of the ruined forest.

"When all the ascendants leave, who do you think will rule this place?"

Jung Heewon answered with a hardened expression.

"Those with the most D-Coins, I suppose."

[The Constellation, 'White Flame Dragon of Sighs', nods.]

[The Constellation, 'Drinking Demon', watches your every move.]

[The Constellation, 'Omnipotent Sun', glares at you.]

I nodded, gazing at the stars that twinkled indifferently.

Jung Heewon asked again.

"So what? To stop them—"

"It's simple. We just have to respond the same way they do."

"They're a corporation. No matter how rich you are, you can't have more coins than them."

I spoke, watching the road to the 'auction house' approaching.

"Normally, that would be the case, but..."

This city was made of my brother's flesh and blood. Therefore, the most 'valuable' things here were already decided.

"It's different in this 'city'."

Perhaps, as Namgung Myung said, the time had come for a wind of change to blow through this Murim.

However, this change would be somewhat different from what Namgung Myung had envisioned.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 936 Episode 55 Giant Tree (2)

"Over there."

I entered the auction house with Jung Heewon. Faint remnants of sparks lingered in the auction house square.

[The 'Probability Appropriate Determination' has now ended.]

I remembered that the last time I entered, a 'Probability Appropriate Determination' had occurred at the request of the Recorders.

"S-Save me..."

Was there a fight here too?

Stalls were scattered everywhere, and weapons were strewn about.

Among the dead incarnations sprawled out, eyes closed, others were lying dead, attempting an ambush.

"Keuk."

One of the assassins, slain by Jung Heewon's blade, rolled back his eyes and died.

"Don't let your guard down."

I nodded, watching Jung Heewon brush away her bloodied sword.

「It's no different from 'proving worth'.」

Perhaps all 'scenarios' are ultimately variations on 'proving worth'.

As long as we live within this story, we must forever prove ourselves, yet perhaps we meet our end without ever proving anything.

And every failure becomes a story.

"But why are you here?"

"To find out the value of my story."

We gathered useful items throughout the auction house and made our way to the center. There, I found the item I was looking for.

「Settlement Scale.」

A device that values 'parts' from the Fear Realm and exchanges them for 'D-Coins'. The scale was clean, indicating the 'personality compatibility assessment' had been completed.

I left Jung Heewon, who was puzzled, behind and approached the scale. This time, a pair of eyes sprouted from the scale stared at me again. I met their eyes, plucked a strand of hair, and placed it on the scale.

[The corresponding part? What is the appraisal result? 10,000 D-Coins? It is.]

This time, the appraisal result was the same. Jung Heewon, who belatedly realized what I was trying to do, spoke.

"Dokja-ssi, that thing?"

"Yes. I'm going to exchange D-Coins now."

"Do you know what that is? It's a suspicious device at first glance."

Jung Heewon was right. I still don't know for sure what this 'scale' is connected to.

The scale eye that had actually checked my hair had been trembling unusually for a while.

I said, without taking my eyes off the scale eye,

"This is the only way for now."

I immediately pulled out the hair.

"Aren't you pulling out too much?"

A clump of hair came out.

Fortunately, Cheon Inho had a lot of hair, so pulling out a few dozen strands wouldn't be a problem.

I placed the hair straight on the scale.

[Appraising 255 parts of the same type.]

[The total appraisal results for this part is 2,550,000 D-Coins.]

"I guess I need to extract more."

"How about just cutting them off? That'll pull out the hair roots."

"Uh..."

I hadn't even considered that.

"Turn around here."

Jung Heewon lightly ran one hand over my head, then swung her cool sword, snipping off every last bit of my hair. In an instant, the severed hair scattered into the air.

Jung Heewon nodded, seemingly satisfied.

"It's a bit neater now."

I gathered the hair with [Way of the Wind] and placed it on the scale.

[Appraising 1,408 additional parts of different sizes.]

That was when faint sparks erupted from the scale.

[Your actions affect your 'Fate'.]

The 'Unchangeable One' spoke.

[Fate, with its uncertain form of justice, is difficult to modify, but there are ways to circumvent it without modification.]

And my plan was to exploit this very vulnerability of [Fate].

「Kim Dokja of the 'New Murim District' will lose his 'precious thing'.」

When I first confirmed that [Fate], I remembered what I had said.

「"You don't seem to understand, but hair is inherently precious."」

The sparkling hair began to be literally 'calculated'. The stories, scattered in light, flowed into the mouth of the scale.

Ultimately, the definition of 'preciousness' differs from person to person.

And in this <Star Stream>, that definition is based on the 'stories' accumulated by each individual.

[You have lost something precious!]

[Your 'Fate' is about to be realized.]

At the same time, messages from the Recorders echoed through the air.

[The 'Recorders of Fear' who bestowed your 'Fate' are suffering a major blow!]

[Some 'Recorders of Fear' are objecting to the 'Fate's' realization.]

[The probability of the <Star Stream> is shifting!]

[Your Fate is only partially realized.]

Is this how it will be?

It was a shame.

Despite my past remarks, 'hair' isn't truly precious to me.

Still, the fact that the influence of [Fate] has weakened was enough of a result.

[Settlement complete.]

But the moment I was about to take the D-Coins before me, I felt as if something was watching me from the vast expanse of space within the jaws of the settlement scale.

[The Constellation, 'The Oldest Liberator', looks at you.]

I jerked, raising my head.

Just now, that was...

Tsutsutsutsutsu!

Sparks swept through the air again, perhaps because the exchange of too many D-Coins had disrupted the probability of the incident.

[Some 'Recorders of Fear' have pointed out the probability of this incident.]

[The Management Bureau is not responding to this request.]

However, this area has already been 'determined as probable', and no further probability reviews will be initiated under the same pretext.

Even if a request were made, Bihyung would block it.

"There they are!"

I saw a crowd gathering from afar. Incarnations rushing to take the tribute from me and Jung Heewon.

I collected the D-Coins in front of them, as if to show off.

[You have acquired a total of 10,040,600 D-Coins.]

This is only a small amount in D-Coins, but if converted to actual coins, it's impossible to even guess how much it would be worth.

The incarnations, their eyes widening, stopped one by one.

"What... how much is that?"

Large amounts of wealth arouse desire in people.

"That's ridiculous—"

However, when the amount far surpasses what ordinary humans can imagine, people tend to feel awe rather than greed.

Not even a hundred thousand, not a million, but ten million D-Coins.

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', is astonished by your wealth!]

[The Constellation, 'Emperor of Power', is greedy for your wealth!]

Even the Constellations were astonished, and silence fell over the area.

[Everyone in the area is temporarily overwhelmed by you.]

Even the Ascended at the back of the crowd stared blankly at me.

I grinned and spoke to them.

"So many of you came here just to catch me."

I summoned some D-Coins into my palm and waved them gently.

"Do you want them so badly?"

I swung my arm with all my might, scattering 10,000 D-Coins worth of goods into the air. The incarnations gaped in amazement, watching the coins scatter like snow.

"Pick them up!"

Several incarnations frantically reached for the coins.

I looked down at them from the platform and said,

"If you pick them up now..."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', activates!]

"You'll have to live your whole life bending over."

The incarnations reaching for the floor hesitated and raised their heads. I continued, stomping on the coins as if to show them off.

"You'll never escape those damned 'coins'."

Under the influence of [Incite], some of the incarnations trembled, others lowered their heads.

And others protested strongly.

"What do you want me to do?"

"We have no chance of ascension anyway! If we don't collect at least some coins—"

I nodded and accepted the words.

"I know. You'll feel like nothing."

The martial artists who had been shouting fell silent one by one.

"To survive in this damned city, you need at least a lot of coins. In this world, everyone lives for themselves. That's what you all think."

"That—"

"But is that really what you truly mean?"

A chilling silence descended upon the room.

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', listens to you.]

[The Constellation, 'Emperor of Power', listens to you.]

[The Constellation, 'Last Ark', listens to you.]

[The Constellation, 'Protector of the Jangpanpa', listens to you.]

The incarnations, and even the Constellations that intuitively perceive the scenario, were listening to me.

"This is not the Demon Realm. This is not Earth, <Asgard>, or <Olympus>. This is—"

I looked around the street.

Atop the ruined streets stood towering humans, no longer leaning on each other.

"This was once Murim."

My brother named this place the 'New Murim'.

"Until the companies showed up and cut down all the trees."

A city born from the destruction of the forest.

A base for humanity to reach the Constellations of the higher scenarios.

"Remember why you gathered here. Was it to earn coins? Was it really the reason you chose 'Murim' over other Constellations—was that really it?"

Even if it wasn't D-Coin, coins can be collected anywhere.

Yet, among all the cities, they chose 'Murim' and settled here.

「The incarnations who settled in Murim once dreamed a similar dream.」

A romantic city where one could learn martial arts, practice repeatedly, and attain enlightenment, reaching one's ultimate self. That was Murim.

"So? What do you want us to do now?"

An Ascendant shouted.

"What difference does it make just because you say so? This is already a city ruled by coins! A world ruled by Constellations, by Nebulae! No matter how plausible you may sound, that fact remains!"

"It can be changed."

"Impossible! No human can stand against the corporation and the Constellations—"

That's right. This is an impossible dream.

"Constellations, Nebulae, corporations. Are they really that great?"

That was the case until just a few days ago.

[The story, 'One Who Witnessed the Truth of the Stars', begins its storytelling.]

A story was being told.

A story of a mere human breaking a star, of defeating Agni of the great <Locapala>, of revealing the true nature of the stars to the world unfolded before my eyes.

"Ah, ahh—"

Some groaned at the story.

"Huh—"

And others were gripped by fear.

Even so, everyone was reading the story, their eyes riveted.

In the end, it was stories that moved people. They made them fight against despair, they persevered on the edge of a precipice.

"Remember. There was a time when you, too, did not bend."

Of course, I didn't believe the incarnations would be persuaded by this. Like the residents of the Recycling Center, their emotions would be fleeting.

Still, what I needed now was that 'moment'.

"There was a time when you, too, did not kneel before against Constellations, and did not despair in the face of overwhelming power."

If only I could remind them, even for a moment, of the forest they had lost.

"We have already been defeated!"

And then a voice was heard.

"What does the Small Alliance want us to do?"

It was a small but powerful voice, like an echo from an ancient forest.

All the incarnations in the hall turned to where the voice had come from. To my surprise, the examiner who had pointed me out and fled earlier was standing there.

I looked down at him for a moment, then turned to the crowd.

"You were the ones who lost, not 'Murim'. So, please uphold the 'covenant' of Murim."

Covenant. Some looked puzzled at those words, while others tilted their heads in confusion.

I looked at them and added,

"Please protect the one who upheld the convention of Murim to the end on your behalf."

At that moment, everyone's expressions became similar.

At least one person, someone in this Murim who had upheld their own convention to the end.

Everyone here knew that name.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

Someone muttered, and someone else answered.

"Come to think of it, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint is also on the list…"

It wasn't the influence of [Incite]. A long-standing nostalgia for Murim was spreading through the crowd like a ripple.

"But even that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was defeated by the Constellations—"

"Back then, didn't the Constellations attack all at once? Now, one of them is gone. And then there's that small thief."

"If only we could rescue Breaking Sword Saint now…"

Many of them had been saved by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. Some owed their lives to her, others attained enlightenment.

Those who respected and revered her spoke up, one by one.

"Where is Breaking the Sky Sword Saint imprisoned?"

"Find Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! We must protect her!"

The Ascendants chanted as if to dissuade them.

"Everyone, wake up! You are— AAAAAH!"

Someone's blade pierced the Ascendant celestial's back.

"Find Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

Jung Heewon and I leaped through the chaotic auction hall and onto a nearby tower. Watching the crowds of people moving through the auction house in search of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, Jung Heewon asked,

"Have people really changed?"

Even amidst this, I looked at the incarnations frantically picking up the D-Coins dropped by the dead incarnations and answered.

"Would people change just because they heard a few words?"

A single story cannot change the essence of existence.

Existence is a collection of stories, and countless stories are needed for a single soul to change.

"Everyone is just swept along by fleeting emotions. Most likely, their goal is to seize the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's offerings or to steal the coins of the dead incarnations and run away."

"Then why, Dokja-ssi—"

"I wanted to give them a justification. A justification that they could still live as martial artists."

With a more powerful [Incite], I might have been able to persuade them. But perhaps the reason I ultimately didn't do so was because I, too, wanted to believe in the 'romance' of martial arts that Namgung Myung spoke of.

[The Constellation, 'Emperor of Power', savors the nostalgia of martial arts.]

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', reminisces about the old Murim.]

[The Constellation, 'Last Ark', feels a strong longing.]

The gazes of the Constellations, radiating bright light in the sky, all turned to one place.

Jung Heewon, who had been observing the direction of the light from the top of the tower, finally seemed to grasp my intention and spoke.

"So that's what you were after."

I nodded.

I don't know if there's still any 'romance' left in this Murim.

However, one thing is certain: there still exist Constellations that consume that 'romance'.

"It seems Breaking the Sky Sword Saint is over there."

"It's on the <Tamra Middle School> side."

I activated [Way of the Wind] and moved there with Jung Heewon.

All along the way, we encountered people chanting the name of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"Still, it seems many people remember Master."

"It can't be helped."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung was the very embodiment of romance in Murim.

The most powerful transcendant. A ruler of Murim who, despite possessing such immense power, didn't wield it easily.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Save Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

"Over there!"

Yoo Joonghyuk once asked Breaking the Sky Sword Saint,

「"With such immense power, why don't you rule Murim? If you step forward, wouldn't Murim be unified?"」

To this, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint replied,

「"[Disciple. If everyone must submit to a single justice, can it be considered right, even if it's a compromise?]"」

Finally, we arrived at the crowded headquarters of <Tamra Heavy Industries>.

"What is that... what is it?"

As Jung Heewon asked, a loud alarm bell rang in my head.

Leaves had completely covered the entire area, including the company's headquarters. Beneath those leaves, the incarnations possessed by the Constellations were rolling on the ground in a horrific state.

I stepped forward as if to protect Jung Heewon and said,

"Heewon-ssi, please step back for a moment."

Jung Heewon stared ahead with trembling eyes. Perhaps she had sensed what this 'forest' was.

「Can a single tree become a forest?」

The answer to that question was perhaps right before my eyes.

And for the first time, I thought about the 'tributes' in this scenario.

The scenario likely arbitrarily measured the strength of the incarnations and assigned them the number of 'tributes'. My offering was 100. Jung Heewon had 40.

And Breaking the Sky Sword Saint—

| |
|---|
| Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung — 500. |

A forest made of a single tree.

The moment I sensed the story embedded in the foliage, I had to accept reality.

「If only one justice becomes a 'world', can it still be called justice?」

A gurgling sound accompanied the sound of the forest before my eyes.

[A Natural Disaster-level Fear has appeared in the 'New Murim'!]

The god who had long protected Murim had become the Fear of this world.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 937 Episode 55 Giant Tree (3)

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"Heewon-ssi."

"Let go."

"No."

Jung Heewon glared at the forest with reddened eyes. I understood her feelings.

The corpses of the incarnations were strewn around the forest. Tree roots had burst through the ground, burrowing into the corpses like tentacles, sucking up their nutrients. Through this nourishment, the forest was growing in real time.

"Please calm down. I'll find a way."

Jung Heewon's eyes were gradually becoming filled with madness. She had acquired the 'Mad Butcher' trait. And Mad Butchers aren't good at controlling their emotions.

I had planned to use [Incite] if necessary, but unexpectedly, Jung Heewon's eyes were slowly regaining their composure.

[Character 'Jung Heewon' is strongly affected by your words and actions.]

"Understood. It'll only be for a moment."

It was unexpected. I felt like she could rush into the forest to rescue Breaking the Sky Sword Saint at any moment. Perhaps this had something to do with my understanding of the characters.

In any case, I had gained some time, so it was time to explore the forest.

I summoned Heir and immediately brought up a story about the 'King of Fear'.

[The story, 'Friend of All Narratives' sings with his eyes closed.]

As the story's song filled the area, the story of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint could be felt throughout the forest.

No matter how many times I thought about it, the conclusion was clear.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint became 'Fear'.」

All fear is rooted in stories. The 'Alien Traffic Light' was the same, as was the 'Festival Tunnel'.

So, could 'existence' also become 'Fear'?

Considering that the foundation of existence is story, it wasn't impossible. For example, even the aliens possessed a clear sense of self, yet within the Fear Realm, they reigned as 'Fear' as a phenomenon. The problem is, this isn't Fear Realm.

[The D-Coin is responding to your story.]

I felt the fragments of the 'D-Coin' writhing at my fingertips.

A thought suddenly occurred to me.

The D-Coin is a substance made from my brother's flesh and blood. Yet, beyond that forest, I sensed a power identical to this D-Coin.

"It seems someone fed the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint some D-Coins."

"D-Coins?"

"Yes, a lot of them."

The D-Coin fundamentally contains the power of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'. This is why skills and items enhanced with D-Coins gained abnormal powers.

「Then what would happen if you fed that 'D-Coin' to an incarnation?」

All beings are made of stories, so eating a 'D-Coin' would strengthen the being's stories.

The problem lies in the situation where this strengthening exceeds a critical threshold. If the D-Coin-enhanced story ran wild within the incarnation, becoming so powerful that it manifested outside of the incarnation.

"Who did this?"

"Probably them."

The moment I looked up into the sky, a familiar star twinkled.

[The Constellation, 'Master of Baekrokdam', smiles sinisterly.]

[Many Constellations condemn the impulsive actions of <Tamra Heavy Industry>!]

As expected, it was the Constellations within <Tamra>. The one responsible for this incident must be the master of that Baekteukdang.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Where are you! We're here!"

"Find Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

The incarnations who had been subjected to my [Incite] finally arrived in the forest. Perhaps the [Incite] had weakened, their eyes now glowed with a deeper greed than before.

「This is a chance to acquire a large amount of D-Coins and tribute.」

Even without using [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], their inner thoughts were palpable.

Ultimately, this was the current state of Murim. A Murim devoid of agreement and consumed by capital.

"Hey, hey, don't push!"

At that moment, several incarnations stepped into the forest. At the same time, as if waiting, stems stretched out and engulfed them.

"Kwaaaaah! What the heck!"

The captured incarnations were instantly stripped of all their D-Coins.

"My, my coins!"

"Ugh!"

The incarnations, drawing their weapons, swung their swords, and the stems instantly pierced their torsos. Screams erupted from all directions.

"This is a cursed forest!"

"Damn it, the headquarters of the <Tamra Heavy Industries> is contaminated with Fear!"

With this, the rules of the forest became clear.

One, this forest takes the D-Coins from intruders. Two, this forest annihilates the presence of hostile intruders.

A Fear of utterly ordinary logic, and that's why I couldn't understand it.

The 'Fear' born from the story of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was so simple?

"Is that the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'?"

The Ascended beings who had been observing the situation nearby appeared one by one.

"A forest that absorbs D-Coins. How interesting."

The Ascendant from each company were gathering in front of the forest. They had already acquired sufficient tribute for their 'ascension'.

Someone I recognized.

"That means clearing this forest will yield a massive amount of 'D-Coins', I suppose."

Reinheit, having recovered from the blow he received from Jung Heewon, was leading the group of Ascended beings.

"Anyway, that's interesting. The story of becoming a tree."

The story of Reinheit, the Lord of Paradise Castle, was activated.

"As it happens, I possess a similar technique."

Reinheit's skin hardened like the epidermis of a tree. Powered by Paradise's 'Perpetual Motion Machine', his massive body began to grow, extending its roots into the ground. Soon, the tree transformed into a humanoid giant.

[The story, 'Giant Tree of the Forest' begins its storytelling.]

The giant tree's feet, reminiscent of massive tree roots, began to advance into the forest.

"All, follow the Lord of Paradise!"

The horde of Ascendants, recklessly destroying the forest, advanced, and more and more people were flocking into the forest. Some were after our tribute.

Whether to save Breaking the Sky Sword Saint or to protect us, we had to enter the forest.

"Heewon-ssi, as you know, this forest is a trap."

The incarnations trapped in this forest will become its sacrifice. The vast amount of D-Coins will be absorbed by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, and ultimately, it will become the portion of <Tamra Heavy Industry>. Of course, that was only if no one had been able to interpret this 'forest'.

「As long as this forest is 'Fear', there must be a way to interpret it.」

It would have been easier to clear the level if I had the 'King of Fear' mode, but for now, I had to delve into the interpretation myself.

"Before we begin, let me tell you a few things."

I continued, rummaging through my coat.

"Judging by the energy I sense from the forest, the inside is likely similar to a 'Fear Realm'."

The most important aspect of a Fear Realm was 'abnormal status'. This forest, in particular, was characterized by a 'Natural Disaster-level' of Fear. Considering the forest's unique location, the likelihood of contracting a mentally polluted status effect was extremely high.

[Would you like to use the 'Limited Edition Random Relic Box' item?]

"Yes."

It was finally time to use the item I had received from Bihyung when I made the contract.

Limited Edition Random Relic Box. It's random, but in reality, these types of draw items in the <Star Stream> had predictable outcomes.

[The relic of the Wei Ingeum Constellation appears!]

As expected, two low-grade relics appeared.

[You have acquired two relics, 'Ambassador's Rosary'.]

At this point, I was beginning to suspect that Ambassador had entered into a merchandise contract with the <Star Stream>.

"Dokja-ssi, that item."

"Yes, that's right."

Ambassador's Rosary.

Unlike the items obtained from the Ambassador's statue at Dongdaemun Station, this item was a true 'relic'.

Moreover, it was an 'anti-demon' item that I needed immediately.

"It's a set item with the sack I gave you earlier."

At my words, Jung Heewon fumbled around in her pocket and pulled something out. Seeing the item she handed me, I was startled and asked,

"You still have it?"

"It's the first item you gave me, Dokja-ssi."

She took out the 'Great Master's Scepter' that I'd procured for her early in the scenarios. Jung Heewon still kept the piece of cloth, now too embarrassing to even call it a giant.

A strange feeling of guilt washed over me.

"Would you mind giving it to me for a moment?"

I took the scepter and used some of the 'D-Coins' on it and the prayer beads.

[Enhance the item using 100,000 D-Coins!]

[The item, 'Great Master's Scepter', evolves into a holy relic!]

[All stats of the 'Great Master's Scepter' are greatly enhanced!]

[The appearance of the 'Great Master's Scepter' changes!]

The scepter, having absorbed a large amount of D-Coins, transformed into a white coat.

Jung Heewon beamed and accepted the scepter.

"It looks just like your coat, doesn't it?"

Jung Heewon lightly put on the scepter. Fortunately, it fit Jung Heewon's body perfectly.

"It suits you well."

Following this, she put on the enhanced Great Master's Prayer Beads on both wrists, and a miraculous light began to swirl around Jung Heewon's body.

[A powerful anti-demon aura protects the user!]

I nodded.

With this level of armor, even entering the forest would be safe for a while. It'll be alright.

"What about you, Dokja-ssi?"

"I'm fine."

"Nothing like that. Just sleep. Use one of the lords, Dokja-ssi."

"I'm really fine. I have strong willpower."

"It's a pack."

We entered the forest straight away. The branches that spotted us flew into the air. The moment Jung Heewon drew her sword and tried to counter them, stories bloomed all over her body.

[The story, 'Disciple of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' begins its storytelling.]

For a moment, the flying branches flinched and then returned to their original position.

「Disciple of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.」

It was the story that Yoo Joonghyuk had.

"It seems she recognizes you, Heewon-ssi."

We used [Way of the Wind] and immediately ran through the forest path.

How long had we run along the path swept by Reinheit's giant tree? The roar of the vanguard soon drew near.

That's when an ominous feeling of foreboding struck me.

"Heewon-ssi, wait—"

The scent of stories had changed on my nose. The forest's 'pattern' had shifted.

The moment Jung Heewon turned to me, a large number of stems burst from the ground, entangling Jung Heewon and me.

"Ah."

I tried to break the stems with brute force, but they wouldn't break.

It was impossible. Even without using a special 'mode', I could now exert strength comparable to that of a Historical-grade.

After struggling for a while, Jung Heewon said,

"It won't break."

Jung Heewon's current strength was comparable to that of most Constellations. But even Jung Heewon couldn't break the vines?

"Over there, over there!"

Just then, I noticed the vines swaying against the tied cage.

The potent incarnations were approaching.

Their objective was obvious, even without asking.

What could I do?

I sighed lightly, and just as I was about to activate 'Demon King of Salvation' mode,

"We'll rescue them!"

The men quickly rushed over and began swinging their swords at the vines entangling me and Jung Heewon.

"They're tough to cut!"

"Keep cutting at the same spot! We'll get there!"

The vines, which wouldn't break on their own, were instantly severed when several joined forces. It was a bizarre occurrence. Incarnations, barely above the initial rank of Historical-grade, were cutting a vine that even I and Jung Heewon couldn't?

Even stranger was their attitude.

"Great Swordsman, are you alright?"

For some reason, they seemed genuinely delighted to have saved us.

"Save the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

A forest story could be heard sporadically amidst the chants of the advance guard.

「"If one tree can't make a forest, how many trees does it take to make a forest?"」

We mingled with them and advanced toward the center of the forest. Soon, the sound of weapons began to be heard. A fierce battle was raging just ahead.

"I'll break through!"

"Everyone, fall back!"

"The left is dangerous! Support from there!"

A massive thicket enveloped the center of the forest. Thorny vines protruded through the thicket like tentacles, engaging in a fierce battle with the incarnations.

Reinheit, who was dealing with the large central thicket, shouted,

"I'll break through the center, no matter what! Take care of the smaller bushes! I'll risk my life to open the way!"

The one there was undoubtedly one of the Ten Evils—Reinheit, the Lord of Paradise.

"We must save Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

But the man shouting this seemed genuinely there to save Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Breaking the Sky Sword Saint is inside!"

It was strange. The incarnations gathered here were all affiliated with different corporations. They had simply entered the forest to acquire more D-Coins, to steal tribute from others.

"We're advancing! Watch your step!"

So what exactly was this scene?

"Ahhhh!"

The incarnation at the forefront, fighting the thornbush, was seriously injured, and another couple of incarnations rushed in to save him.

"Huh! Get out of the way quickly!"

An incarnation swung their sword and died. Another incarnation threw themself at them to protect them.

"I will be your shield!"

The incarnations who had bravely charged into the bushes met a gruesome end. The upper body of an incarnation, torn from its waist, rolled on the ground.

Before their last breath, they muttered something with a rapt expression.

"No! I'll die! Kill me first!"

Jung Heewon, who had been watching blankly, stepped forward and grasped the hilt of her sword. I instinctively grabbed her wrist.

"Heewon-ssi."

Startled, Jung Heewon turned to me and sheathed her sword again.

[The story, 'Regret, Pipe, Obsession' interrupts its storytelling.]

I saw a faint emotion flicker in her eyes, then disappear.

I got goosebumps.

A status abnormality so powerful that even Jung Heewon, wearing the Ambassador Samyeong's holy relic set, found it difficult to touch.

"Protect each other! We can win if we fight together!"

Listening to the deeply elated cries of the incarnations, I thought about the master of this forest.

「What kind of person was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint?」

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. The strongest Transcendent and Yoo Joonghyuk's teacher. Heir to [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] and the god of the <First Murim>. A descendant of the extinct Giant God Clan.

「How can you call a place with only trees a forest?」

With every step toward the forest's center, her voice seemed to echo in my ears.

「Even if not a single blade of grass grows on this land.」

Perhaps this was the answer given by the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint herself.

The answer of the Transcendent, who had long and deeply pondered the meaning of Murim.

「If a group of people with the same beliefs unite.」

An unprecedented fervor welled up deep within my heart. It was a feeling not only I but also any martial artist in the First Murim would feel.

「Only then does this place become 'Murim'.」

People, consumed by an unnatural madness, blindly saved each other and died.

Only then did I realize the true nature of the abnormal state that befell this forest.

「This forest forces 'negotiation' upon those who enter.」

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 938 Episode 55 Giant Tree (4)

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The forest was filled with majestic declarations coming from all sides.

"I'll block it! Make way!"

"No, I'll block it!"

"I'm the one sacrificing!"

People risking their lives for each other. It should have been a moving scene. If it weren't for the effect of 'Fear', it certainly would have been.

Jung Heewon, her expression hardened, called out to me.

"Dokja-ssi."

Jung Heewon seemed to have noticed something strange in the people. Perhaps it was even stranger that they didn't notice. Those who had previously been after our coins were now sacrificing their lives to clear the forest path.

"Is this the forest's effect?"

"I think so."

"You said this forest was created by the Master's stories. But why—"

"Perhaps it's that."

I said, looking at the people risking their lives for each other.

"It must be the 'story' that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint has always wanted."

I thought about Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

That she trained with a sword that would shatter the heavens her entire life. That she was Yoo Joonghyuk's master. That she was also a god of Murim. That the martial artists revered her. That she betrayed them.

But Jung Heewon probably remembered something different from me about Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"That can't be true. There's no way my master would want something like that."

Looking at Jung Heewon, I slowly opened my mouth.

"What do you think justice is, Heewon-ssi?"

Jung Heewon hesitated for a moment at the sudden question before answering.

"Upholding justice."

"Then what is justice?"

"Protecting the weak."

I knew Jung Heewon would answer that way.

「Justice. Standing on the side of justice, helping the weak.」

A place to help the weak, to ensure they never become alone.

Perhaps the 'forest' Breaking the Sky Sword Saint dreamed of—Murim was similar to that.

"A disaster that a single tree cannot prevent can be prevented by many trees. That was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's guiding principle."

I pictured a giant tree nestled in a barren land.

The tree that first proved the land's potential.

When a plant realizes that a place is habitable, one by one, plants begin to sprout and form colonies.

"My master always said that. Heaven can never be destroyed by one person alone."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint knew that destruction would one day come to Murim. Perhaps she dreamed that when the disaster that would destroy it came, people would become each other's trees.

"That landscape, perhaps, depicts her despair."

No matter how large and magnificent a tree grows, it cannot change the entire ecosystem.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint must have known this too. She was the god of Murim, protecting it, but she could not change it. The scene before my eyes was the realization of that god's small wish.

「A forest of knights, where everyone sacrifices their lives for one another.」

The dream she had longed for was finally realized after she returned to Murim as a Fear.

"We have to stop it."

Jung Heewon took a step forward.

"We can't just leave it like that."

I held her back and said.

"It's not your place, Heewon-ssi."

"If we leave them alone, they'll all die."

"You told me, didn't you? Not everyone in this world deserves to be saved."

"I don't particularly want to save those people."

"Really?"

"I just don't want my master to kill them."

Looking into her blazing eyes, I finally understood what she meant. Jung Heewon didn't want those damned Constellations to tarnish the story of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

I sighed softly at her and replied.

"Understood."

"Will you help me?"

"Yes. But blending in with them like this isn't a good idea."

"But Master—"

"The true nature of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint isn't that bush."

This forest is merely a 'phenomenon' in the story.

「This isn't a proper interpretation of Fear.」

If this Fear truly belongs to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, interpreting Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's desires would naturally destroy it.

If so, fighting that meaningless bush, shouting 'justice' and dying, as the story desired, could also be a way.

「Of course, that's only if that's truly 'what Breaking the Sky Sword Saint wants'.」

I looked back at the people dying, shouting for justice. Clearly, at this moment, they were sincere.

But what was that sincerity for? Can sacrificing one's life for someone always be considered noble? Can justice imposed by others truly be called justice?

Did Breaking the Sky Sword Saint truly dream of such a world?

「The one who aimed her sword at the impossible sky.」

Even though she knew humans couldn't destroy the sky, she never gave up her banner of destruction.

At least, if it were the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint I knew, if it were her, the one who had been Yoo Joonghyuk's teacher, she wouldn't have dreamed such a dream.

「The 'landscape' the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint dreams of isn't here.」

I carefully examined my surroundings and began walking toward a heavily overgrown area.

"Wait a minute. That way—"

It's dangerous. I knew it. At a glance, the undergrowth path over there seemed much deeper and denser than the one Reinheit and the other incarnations were ploughing through.

"The forest is where paths are created as people walk."

The moment I stepped through the bushes, vines flew in as if they had been waiting. I didn't resist, but was entangled in them. I saw Jung Heewon reach out to me as I was being sucked in.

I spoke to Jung Heewon.

"Heewon-ssi, think back to your initiation into [Breaking the Sky Kendo]."

"Huh?"

Before I could even answer, the vines pulled me into the bushes. A strong, suffocating sensation gripped my entire body. Despite feeling the vines threatening to suffocate me, I surrendered my body without much fear. The vines wrapped around me, as if examining my incarnation body, then slowly released me.

As expected, it was as expected.

[A Natural Disaster-level Fear, '■■■■ ■■', responds to you.]

The vines placed me deep within the forest.

「The sky remains where it is, and only humans resent it.」

Initiation into Breaking the Sky Kendo means understanding one's own anger toward the stars.

In other words, it means coming to a keen realization that the sky exists regardless of one's emotions.

The logic of this forest wasn't to steal 'D-Coins' or to threaten intruders.

「This forest reacts to the 'emotions' of those who enter it.」

The incarnations were robbed of their D-Coins because they feared losing them, and they were attacked because they feared the forest would attack them.

A moment later, Jung Heewon, engulfed in vines, landed beside me. She stood up, stunned, and stumbled toward me.

I extended my hand and smiled.

"You did as I said."

Jung Heewon must have successfully recalled the introductory training method of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship].

"The vines suddenly stopped attacking? How did you figure that out?"

"Fear is forcing a certain emotion, so I simply thought the opposite."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had once said something like this in the Ways of Survival.

「"Justice is cold rage."」

If that sentence is true, then at least the justice Breaking the Sky Sword Saint desired would begin with a calm mind.

"It feels just like the moment when the scenario first started!"

Ooooooooo.

The eerie howl coming from afar sounded like a human calling for help, or perhaps the name of an unknown beast living in the forest.

We'd somehow passed the first barrier, but we hadn't yet encountered Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. We'd only just passed the bark of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint tree.

"What next? Where do we go?"

"Just a moment."

I frantically read the stories circulating throughout the forest. If this Fear originated from the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's story, there must have been a hint in the stories I'd read.

How long had I been moving, desperately recalling the 'Ways of Survival'?

"There's something ahead."

Jung Heewon was the first to stop. We hid among the nearby trees, surveying the situation.

After holding our breath for a moment, we sensed a presence up ahead.

Could it be that some incarnation had entered this forest before us?

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

Someone called Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's name. Even at first glance, it was a roar filled with majestic magic.

"We've come to save you! Where are you!"

The moment I heard that roar, I got goosebumps. Because I, too, had heard that voice before.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Captain! Answer!"

Captain. I knew well the people who called Breaking the Sky Sword Saint that way.

"They're the Transcendents."

They were the Transcendents of the Transcendents Alliance who had escaped by train.

「"Our Youngest, has the end come?"」

The people who had called me 'Kim End-nim'. They, too, had visited this forest after hearing news of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint—!"

Surely, if they were the Transcendents, they would have passed the first gate unscathed by the 'covenant' imposed by this forest.

Even in this terrifying forest, there existed a force they could trust and rely on. And above all, the fact that those Transcendents were here—

「Yoo Joonghyuk might be nearby.」

I unconsciously stepped out of cover.

[Currently, 'Midday Tryst' cannot be activated.]

Even though eight years had passed since the destruction of the Fear Realm, and even 'Midday Tryst' was impossible to communicate with, if that damned Regressor was nearby...

I slowly walked forward, just as I was about to call out to the Transcendents.

Kugugugu.

A corner of the forest trembled slightly, and something emerged from the bushes on the other side.

The Transcendents greeted it with delight and opened their mouths.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

The figure who had emerged from the bushes certainly looked familiar.

A half-breed of the Giants. A martial arts master who had dedicated her life to pursuing martial arts that would shatter the heavens.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung.」

But the moment I saw its form, a chill ran down my spine. What the heck is that?

The feeling that something I thought I knew was becoming something I didn't know.

「■■■■ Namgung Minyoung.」

I looked around, and Jung Heewon was trembling too.

「■■■■ ■■■■.」

Alarm bells rang in my head.

I had to stop them. No, I had to run away from here immediately.

"Breaking the Sky Sword—"

The heads of the Transcendents who had uttered those words rolled on the floor like toys. The sound of something being torn apart followed.

Each and every Transcendent of the 'Transcendent Alliance' was at least a being approaching the level of a Great-grade Constellation.

Those powerful beings perished without even a scream.

I barely managed to open my mouth to speak.

"Heewon-ssi, run."

The smell of those 'Natural Disaster-level Fears' that had long rotted away in the Time Fault.

All my stories defined what she had become.

「Outer God.」

It wasn't simply that she was an Outer God. I'd faced Outer Gods countless times before. The problem was her strength.

"That being—"

A pitch-black figure spotted me and rushed towards me. Suddenly, I thought I might actually die this time.

"It possesses power comparable to a Mythical Constellation."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 939 Episode 55 Giant Tree (5)

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The approaching Breaking the Sky Sword Saint—I had a gut feeling the moment I saw her, now an Outer God.

「It’s not as good as Zeus, who descended upon the Fear Realm.」

Not all Constellations classified as 'Myth-grade' are equal. Just as the 'Demon King of Salvation', who had just reached Myth-grade in two days, and the 'Seat of Lightning', were not on equal footing.

「But she’s not an opponent I can face now.」

Even using 'Demon King of Salvation' mode, my maximum output was at the late-stage of Narrative-grade. While there was only a difference between the late-stage of the Narrative-grade and the early-stage of Myth-grade, the scale of their power was on a whole other level.

I looked around and saw Jung Heewon standing frozen, her feet frozen.

「The primal power of the 'Fear'.」

Just as an ordinary human would freeze when confronted by a beast, all beings below Narrative-grade would lose their fighting spirit in the face of a Myth-grade

Constellation. Of course, guys as crazy as Yoo Joonghyuk would charge regardless of their opponent's status—

"Heewon-ssi! Come to your senses!"

Jung Heewon didn't budge despite my shout. She must have been overwhelmed by the Mythical status, completely out of her mind.

Damn it.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was charging toward me.

I quickly closed the distance between us and raised my voice.

"Nameless Fear, reveal your name immediately!"

I didn't know exactly what 'that thing' was disguised as the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. To interpret the Fear, I first needed to identify its source.

[The story, 'Friend of All Narratives', continues singing.]

「All Fears will reveal their names before the throne.」

Is this because I had forcibly unleashed the power of the 'King of Fear'? I felt a shiver run through my body, and dizzying sparks began to course through my veins.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's pitch-black eyes stared at me.

【Na me】

Those who ask for the name of something are obligated to bear the weight of that name.

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', glares.]

[The Constellation, 'Emperor of Power', groans at the power of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.]

[Many Constellations point out the probability of the scenario!]

The Constellations, belatedly confirming the power of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, flashed a fierce light in the air.

Tsutsutsutsutsutsu!

[The Natural Disaster-level Fear, 'Impossible Chivalry', is looking at you.]

The Impossible Chivalry. That was the name of the Fear into which the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had evolved.

Faced with that Fear, I opened my mouth again.

"I…!"

There are various ways to interpret Fear when faced with it. You can assimilate into it, or understand it.

"I have not come to harm you!"

Or you can [Incite] Fear.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', activates!]

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Wake up! Don't you know who I am? It's me! Kim End, the youngest of the Transcendent Alliance!"

I roared like a madman at the approaching Fear.

"We fought together, didn't we? In the final scenario of the 40th Round—you were there when the Fear Realm was destroyed!"

My words evaded her like a fish slipping through a coarse net.

In fact, inciting a Fear on the scale of a 'Natural Disaster' was absurd. But there was no other way right now. I had to buy time, no matter what.

Now, less than ten paces remained between Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and me. It was time to take a gamble.

"What will Kyrgios think when he sees this?"

No matter how coarse the net, if you keep casting, something will inevitably get caught.

"How pathetic! This is why they say the world is a paradox! Why do you talk so much!"

For the first time, something resembling emotion flashed across her pitch-black eyes.

I seized the opportunity and continued to babble.

"Remember your disciple! That damned handsome man with your exact style! What would he say if he found out you were fooled by a story and ended up like this!"

Her steps, which had been drawing near, suddenly stopped.

"Do you know why he comes to you every time he regresses? Why, despite so many betrayals, he trusts you? Why does he confide in you alone—"

The moment I spoke, a pitch-black energy began to flow from Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's entire body.

【Yoo Joong hyuk】

"Yes, that's right. Yoo Joonghyuk! If you've come to your senses, you should go slap that damned disciple's ass…"

The moment I met Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's gaze, I realized something.

「This isn't the kind of 'Fear' I can persuade or incite.」

The aura of D-Coins rippled through her body. The coins, made from my brother's flesh and blood, were disrupting my [Incite] and strengthening Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

「But even if it were Kim Dokja's flesh and blood, is it possible to bestow such powerful power upon an incarnation?」

「Is it even possible to transform a Transcendent into a Mythical Fear?」

Cold sweat ran down my spine.

"Dokja-ssi."

Jung Heewon, just as she regained consciousness, turned to me. I gave her a slight nod and stepped forward.

【Di ? Sci ? Ple】

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, approaching, muttered something incomprehensible as she raised her hand. A sword energy that seemed at least several dozen meters thick was surging from her hand.

【I'm sor ry】

If I get hit by that, I'll die. Even if the Great Demon King of Salvation descends, not the Demon King of Salvation, he can't stop it.

「Therefore, the difficulty of this scenario is clearly abnormal.」

I summoned the 'Unchanging One'.

"Unchanging One! Now is the time!"

There was a reason I was desperately trying to buy some time.

[Many Constellations doubt the probability of this scenario.]

I needed time to describe this absurd situation in even the slightest detail.

Ultimately, the story of this world is driven by the probability of the Constellations.

All scenarios are regulated by the Constellations that watch over them.

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', agrees with the unfairness of the scenario.]

[The Constellation, 'Emperor of Power', agrees with the unfairness of the scenario.]

Of course, the reason they were pointing out the probability wasn't simply because of the scenario's difficulty.

[The Constellation, 'Omnipotent Sun', declares that a mere human could never attain the level of Myth.]

[The Constellation, 'Blacksmith of the Volcano', shakes its head.]

[The Constellation, 'God King of Thunder', says a mere half-breed of a giant is...]

They simply cannot tolerate a mere mortal daring to claim a higher status than themselves.

[The Constellation, 'One Who Draws the Boundaries of the Seas', expresses strong displeasure.]

The next moment, sparks flew through the air, and the record of the Constellations' approval gained momentum.

The probability of the <Star Stream> finally began to shift.

Those who manage this world's scenarios are the ones who make that probability a reality.

[Huh, the appearance of a Myth-grade Outer God! How did the Murim incarnations come to face such a great ordeal?]

A Dokkaebi.

[Simple, one-sided academic discussions are no fun. Okay, shall we impose some rules?]

A message floated into the air, accompanied by a seemingly joyful, intangible voice.

[A new sub-scenario has been created!]

Asking the name of the Fear, asking questions to buy time, gathering the Constellations, and completing the records to persuade them.

All of this preparation was solely to reach this moment.

[The sub-scenario has arrived!]

**<Sub-scenario — Defeating Fear>**

Category: Main

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: Defeat the Natural Disaster-level Fear, '■■■■ ■■'.

Time Limit: —

Reward: ???

Failure: The destruction of Murim

The scenario came down like an emergency order.

The content was simple:

Defeat Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who had become an Outer God.

Looking at the scenario alone, the situation didn't seem to have changed much, but from my perspective, things were a little different.

「Every scenario has a 'strategy'.」

The fact that 'Fear' has become a scenario means at least a feasible 'strategy' has been created.

As the scenario was created, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint paused for a moment, and I exchanged glances with Jung Heewon.

'Heewon-ssi.'

Jung Heewon replied.

'Are you sure?'

I nodded.

And then, as if we had agreed in advance, we started running.

「Even if Breaking the Sky Sword Saint absorbed D-Coins, there's no way she could cross the 'mythical' boundary so easily.」

This scenario is based on the records I relayed to the 'Unchangeable One'. In other words, this scenario exists to explain Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's 'unreasonable strength'.

The moment Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's slowly moving eyes fixed on me, I pointed into the air and shouted.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Of course, Yoo Joonghyuk wasn't there. Fortunately, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, whose intelligence had been slightly diminished, followed my finger and stared blankly into space.

「Perhaps Breaking the Sky Sword Saint is exerting mythical power under a few constraints.」

I stared at the pitch-black bush where Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had first appeared.

"Over there!"

「In other words, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's strength is only effective within this forest.」

Perhaps, deep within this forest, something that gave rise to the 'Myth-grade Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' must be hidden.

And of course, the place it was hidden was—

「The place guarded by the 'Impossible Chivalry'.」

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's sword moved. A strike reminiscent of Zeus or Odin's thunderbolt, a strike that would shatter the heavens.

"Now!"

The moment the lightning struck, we were thrust into the pitch-black bushes by a hair's breadth.

We staggered to our feet, a pain that felt like our bodies were being crushed.

"This isn't the end. They'll catch up soon."

Before Breaking the Sky Sword Saint could find us, we first had to understand this forest.

[You have entered 'Myeonggyeongmok.']

However, the moment we were confronted with the spectacle before us, both Jung Heewon and I were momentarily lost in our own minds.

Myeonggyeongmok.

It referred to the titanic ability to read others' emotions. But what unfolded before our eyes were not eyes.

What unfolded before our eyes—

「How far can one person's universe extend?」

A gigantic tree, its size almost beyond comprehension.

"Ah..."

The tree, stretching toward distant galaxies, branched into dozens of branches, covering the sky.

The moment I reached out to the tree, a story spoke to me.

「"What a handsome fellow. What's your name?"」

「"Are you saying you wish to learn swordsmanship from me?"」

Only then did I understand what this giant tree was. It was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's annual rings. It was the sum total of the history she had built while reigning as the god of Murim.

Jung Heewon muttered, unable to hide her awe.

"So this is... Master."

"No, not the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint we know."

"Huh?"

Even if she reigned as a deity of Murim for a long time, could the story of one person be this vast?

「The reason she became a 'Natural Disaster-level Fear'.」

I looked up at the sky. Then, the memories clinging to the branches spoke to me.

「That was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's first death.」

Every branch that reached the sky was etched with her death.

「"Run away, Joonghyuk-ah."」

Some Breaking the Sky Sword Saints died in a combined attack by the returnees.

「"I'm sorry I couldn't keep my promise."」

Some Breaking the Sky Sword Saints died fighting the Constellations to protect Yoo Joonghyuk.

「"You can become stronger."」

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was neither a Returnee nor Reincarnated. There was no way Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, living the life of a mere human, could have experienced so many deaths.

「All these deaths are 'recorded' in Yoo Joonghyuk's memories.」

Memories spanning thousands, if not tens of thousands, of years, etched onto the tree twinkled brightly like stars.

「"Master, I have come to see you."」

Every time Yoo Joonghyuk visited Murim, he would come to her and tell her what had happened in the past.

No, to be precise, he didn't even need to tell her. By simply releasing the mental barrier, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint could access Yoo Joonghyuk's history through the [Myeonggyeongmok].

「Only those who regress remember everything.」

Perhaps that statement was false.

There was at least one person, a tree that had endured his years with him.

「The one who had been Yoo Joonghyuk's companion through all those times.」

The master Yoo Joonghyuk trusted more than anyone else, and relied on more than anyone else.

「"There will come a day when I have nothing left to teach you."」

Every time Yoo Joonghyuk returned, this tree would have continued to grow. Hearing of his tragedy, remembering his death.

「"The day will surely come, disciple, when you will become a Transcendent without my help, when I will no longer be needed."」

It would have accumulated rings.

「"But even when that day comes, come to Murim once more. In this forest, to me, who will still remember nothing—"」

The one who listened to his story, grieving the fate of her disciple, who must fight alone against the destruction of the world.

「"Tell me your story again."」

From now on, I must cut her down.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 940 Episode 55 Giant Tree (6)

"Dokja-ssi."

When I looked up, Jung Heewon was shaking her head, still holding my wrist.

"Even for you, Dokja-ssi, this is unacceptable."

Jung Heewon's eyes were filled with determination. She had already sensed what I was thinking.

"If we leave this tree alone, Murim will be destroyed."

The sub-scenario's core objective was to eradicate the 'Impossible Justice', a Natural Eisaster-level Fear. And to do so, I had to cut down this giant tree before me.

"It's Master."

As if responding to Jung Heewon's words, the tree spewed out a story.

「"Will you become my disciple? Then take this sword."」

Jung Heewon grabbed the sword. In her trembling grip, the swordplay of Mikazuchi Munechika trembled.

A blade sharpened, imbued with the power of D-Coins.

Jung Heewon turned on me with the blade that had protected me until now.

[Natural Disaster-level Fear, 'Impossible Justice', smiles brightly at you.]

I calmly met her eyes, trembling with anxiety.

「This was Jung Heewon's justice.」

Was her justice forced by this forest, or did she realize it herself?

"Heewon-ssi."

I took a step toward her, and she took a step back.

"Don't come near me."

"This tree is not the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

I looked up at the tree. I gazed at the branches that stretched out toward the sky, their ends seemingly endless.

"This tree—"

Undoubtedly, the history of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was imbued within this tree. But can we truly say that the very collection of histories constitutes that very existence?

Her soul had blossomed completely into Fear, and she was no longer here.

What remained here now was the history of Yoo Joonghyuk, learned and mastered through the [Clear Mirror Vision] over the years—the sorrow endured by the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint of all world lines.

[The story, 'Friend of All Narratives', trembles painfully.]

With a feeling of dizziness, the stories she had experienced jumbled together in my ears.

Some knowledge is hell.

The forest, humans, Murim, her disciple, Yoo Joonghyuk.

For a moment, in a state of Fear that felt like my head was going to burst, I gasped for breath and barely managed to finish speaking.

"It is I."

Perhaps my brother had already anticipated this moment.

He in the Snowfield, who hated me becoming Kim Dokja, who wished to be reborn as something other than Kim Dokja, may have been preparing this space—this Fear—for me.

My brother was speaking. The end we seek after such a gruesome struggle is nothing more than a giant tree.

「Can you cut this time?」

There lay the history of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's fight to protect her disciple.

The Master's struggle to lighten his burden, even if she couldn't return with her disciple.

「"Next time, try this method."」

As the Rounds continued, the Master's words continued.

「"You don't have to obsess over the sword. You have your own speed, so training other martial arts might also be a solution. In that sense, in this Round..."」

She sacrificed her own life.

「"Based on the enlightenment you imparted, I modified the moves of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship]."」

She strengthened Yoo Jonghyuk in the next Round.

But even that help had its limits. At some point, her disciple's growth surpassed her own capabilities. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint ultimately realized that what she could offer him wasn't her talent or her martial arts prowess.

「Impossible Justice.」

It was her spirit.

A will that would not break no matter how many times it was shattered.

Even amidst human persecution, she never knelt, but looked up to the heavens, and ultimately challenged the authority of the Constellations.

「"Disciple. Don't lose your faith."」

What percentage of Kim Dokjas must gather to become a complete Kim Dokja?

I don't know the answer. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint likely didn't know either.

「"I will die again. The things that are precious to you will leave you time and time again."」

Instead, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint silently counted the years her disciple had lived.

「"Don't lose your smile. Don't forget the taste of Murim dumplings."」

My brother must have read this story before me.

「"In every Round, there were people who loved you. Even if one day you forget everything, even if you despair over the scenarios and give up on life, don't forget that even for you, there were definitely people who loved you."」

This story must have made him sad, despair, and sigh.

「"In those moments when the pressure is too much and you crumble, it's okay to give up. It's okay to put aside what's precious to you for a moment, to throw everything away and run away. That's okay. You deserve it. Because only you have the chance to save this world, only you deserve to give it up."」

And he told me this story.

「"When your wandering ends, come find me in the next round. Then I will accept you as my disciple. Life will begin again, as if nothing had happened, as if no tragedy had ever occurred. And so, spring will pass, summer will pass, fall will pass, and winter will pass. Disciple, live like that. Even if the scenarios never end, even if you can never escape that curse—"」

Snowfield Kim Dokja was asking. Can you destroy this, and reach the scenario's conclusion with your own flesh and blood, imbued with this story?

「"You are someone's hope simply by being alive."」

Blood seemed to flow from my skin where it touched the tree.

"I don't know what you're talking about," Jung Heewon said.

I looked at Jung Heewon and replied.

"Yes. I don't have the confidence to explain it either."

I now consider this tree 'me'. How could I fully convey such a crazy thought to Jung Heewon?

"You don't have to try to explain it. I won't understand anyway. I'm not Dokja-ssi."

[The story, 'Disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint', begins its storytelling.]

"So I will stop Dokja-ssi."

The aura emanating from her body grew stronger and stronger.

This was the true effect of this 'forest'. A forest that empowered those who carried out their own agenda.

Jung Heewon's [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] was evolving in real time.

"Heewon-ssi, you're currently being consumed by the effects of 'Fear'."

"I'm only trying to protect my master."

"That tree isn't the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

"I can sense my master's story. This tree is her."

"If Heewon-ssi protects that tree, people will die."

"They deserve to die."

"I know you're not serious."

"No, I'm serious."

Jung Heewon continued, her voice filled with determination.

"Dokja-ssi, I'm not driven by grand ethics or morals. Of course, I don't want to be a crazy murderer. But..."

Not all justices can be as fair and impartial as the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. No, perhaps such a fair and impartial justice might actually be far removed from a humane one.

"There are things more precious to me than those nameless people. People who are precious to me. Protecting them is more important to me."

In that sense, Jung Heewon's current justice was more humane than anyone else's.

Protecting the precious people before her.

That justice also resembled Kim Dok-ja's. To carry out that small justice, Kim Dokja ultimately had to break into countless pieces.

So, as a member of Kim Dokja, shouldn't I also have something to say?

"Is that so?"

This justice is firm. Therefore, it must never be shaken by cowardly means like [Incite].

"Dokja-ssi?"

"If that's truly your resolve."

With each step I took, Jung Heewon's sword trembled.

"I will accept it."

She hesitated and backed away as I approached without hesitation.

"If you come any closer—"

I gripped her cold blade with my hand. And then, thrusting it straight into my heart.

"No!"

Jung Heewon, who had cried out hysterically, belatedly withdrew her sword.

[Character 'Jung Heewon's' special effect activates.]

[Character 'Jung Heewon' is consumed by 'madness.']

Stories were leaking from my chest, where the sword had pierced it. Jung Heewon, who had been blankly watching, screamed and approached.

"Dokja-ssi! Are you okay? Are you okay? Are you okay? Are you okay?"

Jung Heewon repeatedly asked if I was okay, like a madman. I grabbed her shoulder and tried to calm her down.

"Heewon-ssi."

"Bleeding. You're bleeding. It keeps bleeding."

The tip of my chest was slightly pricked, but since I quickly retrieved the sword, it wasn't a deep wound.

I held her shoulders more firmly with both hands and reassured her.

"It's okay."

Jung Heewon's eyes continued to waver.

"I, I..."

"Heewon-ssi didn't stab me."

「"There are things more precious to me than those nameless people. People who are precious to me. Protecting those people is more important to me."」

That was Jung Heewon's justice.

And I truly believed it.

"And I won't cut down this tree."

"...Huh?"

"Actually, I think Heewon-ssi is right."

This tree was definitely not Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. Yet, it was clearly part of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"There's someone who absolutely must see this tree."

The only being in this universe capable of defying time. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's memories had to be passed on to him. He had to know how long she had endured, what kind of life she had endured, and what she wanted to give him.

[The Natural Disaster Fear, 'Impossible Justice' responds to your justice.]

"But before that, there's something I have to take care of first."

I said, letting the stories welling up in my chest scatter into the air.

"Why don't you stop watching and come out? My head's been spinning from all that whining."

With my words, light shone from the tips of the branches of a distant tree. It flashed.

A dozen or so Constellations slowly descended from the sky, accompanied by a hair-raising sensation.

[I can't believe it. Is there really a story with such a scent?]

[He was right. I never thought he'd find his way here.]

[Is that guy really that 'being'?]

A mantra murmured, and at the center of that mantra stood two mighty, silent Constellations.

One was a tall, handsome Constellation with a bright, artificial sun overhead, and the other two were Constellations covered in rough wolf skins.

The two Constellations, feeding on the flesh and blood of my brother, were finally on the verge of reaching the level of Mythical Constellations.

"Apollo, the Omnipotent Sun. Vidar, the Terminator of War."

Facing me, Apollo spoke.

[We've finally met, 'Fragment of Discarded Dreams'.]

"Did you bring 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' to this state?"

[She was the one who chose it. We merely granted the mortal's wish to form a forest of her own.]

The Breaking the Sky Sword Saint tree must be growing in real time even now. The tree that devoured <Tamra Heavy Industry> will soon devour all the incarnations, forming a single forest of its own.

Thus, this tree will alone become 'Murim'.

"Do you plan to collect all the D-Coins scattered throughout the city at once through Breaking the Sky Sword Saint?"

Instead of answering, the Constellations remained silent. Observing their expressions, I asked again.

"Did my brother tell you to wait here?"

[Brother?]

A strange mockery flickered across Apollo's face.

[Do you think you can dare impersonate his brother?]

"And yet, you can't take your eyes off the story I've been telling you."

I haven't fully recovered from my 'King of Fear' power yet. They were too numerous for me to fight them using only my 'Demon King of Salvation' mode.

That's why I deliberately got stabbed by Jung Heewon's swordsmanship and let out a story.

If only I could divert the attention of the Constellations for a moment longer.

"Answer my question, and I'll even spare you a finger."

[You arrogant brat.]

"Why, of all times, did you make the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint out of wood? Was this also something my brother ordered?"

[Fragment of a discarded dream, it's beyond your imagination.]

But the Constellations, seemingly unwilling to give me time, refused to answer and began to surround us.

[Subdue them.]

I pushed back the still-half-conscious Jung Heewon and raised my voice.

「Why did they have to make Breaking the Sky Sword Saint out of 'wood' now?」

It could have been done simply to collect the city's D-Coins, or perhaps to lure me. But even that didn't quite add up.

「Why did it have to be 'now'?」

If they were simply targeting me or planning to hoard D-Coins, they had plenty of opportunities before.

But they had waited eight years, and only after I showed up did they put their plan into action.

Eight years.

A thought suddenly occurred to me.

「"You will prosper the city until my brother arrives here. And thus, you will prepare the final story of the <Star Stream>."」

Snowfield Kim Dokja said. The final story of the <Star Stream> would be completed through this city.

What came to mind was the words of Moral I'd encountered in the 'Archive'.

「【'Ragnarok' will soon begin.】」

I knew what 'Ragnarok' was.

A grand narrative and scenario of destruction for <Asgard>. A fateful twilight that signified the end of the gods.

「The World Tree will tremble, all trees will scream, and the Serpent of Twilight will devour their roots.」

Once 'Ragnarok' begins, all of Asgard will be engulfed in the flames of Musheim. Then, even Yggdrasil, the World Tree that forms the foundation of <Asgard>, will be consumed by the flames.

"You, could it be—"

Yet, just before that great apocalypse, a new tree was growing here.

A tree formed from the memories of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, imposing the dream of peace upon the entire world.

"Are you planning to create the next 'World Tree' here?"

The Constellations held back their laughter.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 941 Episode 55 Giant Tree (7)

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[The Constellation, 'Terminator of War', expresses strong hostility toward you.]

According to folklore, Vidar, the 'Terminator of War', was a Constellation that played a crucial role in Ragnarok.

He was the son of Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father', and a central Constellation in Asgard.

Because of this, he must have been quite offended by my mention of the 'World Tree'.

"Now I understand the situation."

I smiled and slowly turned to them.

"So you plan to use me as fertilizer for this 'tree'."

There are several ways for a Constellation of folklore to leap to mythical status.

One is to steadily build up a series of stories, large and small, reaching the realm of myth through a gradual rise to mythic status.

However, this method takes a long time, and there's no guarantee of reaching mythical status. That's why some Constellations prefer the traditional method.

It was to trigger a 'Giant Tale Scenario' and become the ruler of destruction and creation.

For example, <Hongik> nurtured the Divine Dansoo, and <Asgard> nurtured the World Tree Yggdrasil.

「These guys intend to use the tree of the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' as the foundation of a new world.」

"It would be more beneficial for you, the ones who realize the 'Giant Tale' through me, than to consume me immediately."

Even by taking my fragments, you could elevate your original status.

However, fundamentally, only the 'Oldest Dream' can properly process the 'Kim Dokja Fragments'. Therefore, even if you consume me, they won't be able to properly digest the stories of the 'Oldest Dream'.

Therefore, they plan to process me into a 'story' they can digest.

"Didn't my brother promise you again? If you ascend with this tree, he'll recognize you as a Myth-grade Constellation in the new world?"

[That's not something you need to know—]

"Do Odin and Zeus know about what you're doing?"

[...]

"They don't seem to know."

If a lower scenario was so big that it grew the seeds of the 'World Tree', and the higher scenarios didn't notice, then I had to assume a cataclysmic event was unfolding there.

I don't know, but it probably means there's a major conflict between Giant Nebulae, or a clash between Myth-grade Constellations.

[I don't need to hear any more. Deal with it.]

With a loud explosion, over a dozen Constellations simultaneously unleashed their attacks at me. These attacks ranged from the late Historical-grade to the mid Narrative-grade.

In the past, they would have been quite intimidating.

"You seem to be mistaken—"

I blinked slowly, and I felt the story within my body spinning furiously.

[I haven't been idle for eight years.]

With this mantra, the story within me began to speak.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', begins its storytelling.]

Pitch-black wings protruded from the wingtips, deflecting all the attacks from the incoming Constellations. A blue-white lightning flashed from the red horns atop my head, and with a twitching sensation in my right arm, the story of the Demon King of Salvation manifested.

[The story fragment, 'Sword Master's Right Arm Stung by His Colleague', begins its storytelling again.]

On the day the Star Ladder descended, the Demon King of Salvation used one of his story blades to its fullest potential, slicing down the Constellations.

I could now emulate that monstrous story interpretation skill of that day.

「I am Kim Dokja.」

The [Incite] I had been harboring within me manifested, and a surge of Baekcheong-ganggi instantly decapitated several nearby Constellations.

Apollo and Vidar widened their eyes in shock as they watched the late Historical-grade and early Narrative-grade Constellations fall with a single blow.

[You've reached the late Narrative-grade?]

I grinned and retorted.

[Why, why shouldn't we?]

As the confidently charging Constellations suddenly lost their momentum, Apollo, finally regaining his composure, uttered a warning.

[Just because he's late Narrative-grade doesn't change anything. He's alone. Keep your distance and gradually weaken his power.]

At Apollo's command, the Constellations reorganized their battle lines. Small bows appeared in the hands of the Constellations that had escaped the range of [Baekcheong-ganggi].

「The Standard Artemis Bow.」

I also knew this item. It was mass-produced by Olympus in Hephaestus' workshop in preparation for the 'Gigantomachia'.

Although it was a replica of a sacred relic, it was crafted from amethyst metal, so its power rivaled that of a sacred relic belonging to a Constellation of considerable power.

[Shoot.]

I activated [Way of the Wind] and dodged the incoming arrows. Those I couldn't dodge, I deflected them with my blade. Each shot put a heavy strain on my right arm, but I could still withstand it.

「That flame is the driving force behind the sun chariot.」

Apollo, who had been observing the situation, seemed to have decided this couldn't go on, and was the first to intervene. As Apollo's chariot began to move, the artificial sun radiating light behind him erupted in flames.

I deliberately avoided the creature's flames by focusing on the tree, the very essence of the 'Impossible Justice'. In an instant, the air around the area boiled and the forest began to scream.

Vidar, unable to bear it any longer, shouted,

[Apollo, stop! Are you planning to burn down the entire World Tree?]

Their goal was to use me as fertilizer for this tree. As long as this limitation existed, even at a slight disadvantage in terms of combat power, I had a chance of victory.

And contrary to their claims, I wasn't alone.

"Heewon-ssi!"

With a clap of thunder, the head of a Constellation that had been firing arrows was severed.

[Kwaaaaak!]

Jung Heewon, with her 'Mad Butcher' trait in full effect, was rampaging through the Constellations.

[The story, 'Disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' continues its storytelling.]

Perhaps it was because this space was made up of the stories of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'. Jung Heewon, without even using [Time of Judgment], was demonstrating combat prowess on par with me, a late-stage Narrative-grade fighter.

[Mad Sword Emperor! It's the Mad Sword Emperor!]

The Constellations, belatedly noticing Jung Heewon's presence, began to respond, but in an instant, their forces were already halved.

[Omnipotent Sun! You never said that person was with him!]

[How could a mere incarnation—]

It's worth fighting. If we steadily reduce their forces one by one, leaving only Apollo and Vidar...

[Tamra! How long are you going to just watch!]

Apollo's mantra rang out, and the southern sky lit up.

Damn it, things couldn't be resolved that easily.

[The Constellations of Nebula <Tamra> gaze upon the battlefield!]

This is the territory of <Tamra Heavy Industry>, even within the 'New Murim District'. The Constellations that originally occupied this area have finally begun to intervene.

[You came in first like a rat, and now you look pathetic.]

A flash of light emanated from the sky, accompanied by an eerie sensation. I raised my head and saw over fifty Constellations falling.

A tremendous spectacle of light filled one side of the sky.

With the words of the 'Ways of Survival' flashing through my mind, I immediately recognized them.

「'The Five Hundred Generals'.」

The Mythical Constellation of Tamra—the descendants of Seolmundae Halmang, the 'Island of Pregnancy', and the key figures who enabled the small Constellation Tamra to stand against the giant Constellation.

They were led by a long-haired goddess with an uncanny waist.

[The Constellation, 'Master of Baekrokdam', reveals her true character.]

Master of Baekrokdam. One of the great generals of Tamra, leading the Five Hundred Generals.

「General Halla.」

The great general of Tamra, representing the Korean Peninsula alongside Hongik, finally revealed her true form.

Apollo, narrowing his eyes, rebuked her.

"Halla, why are you so late?"

Perhaps it was because some of the Five Hundred Generals, the main force of Tamra, were strong. An ominous air of probability was flowing through the skies.

"Dokja-ssi."

Jung Heewon, standing beside me, spoke nervously. I exchanged a glance with her and then looked at General Halla.

General Halla, too, was a Constellation that had consumed my brother's flesh and blood. I had been thinking that perhaps it was time for her to appear. The fact that she had even descended here with some of the Five Hundred Generals must mean she was serious about this matter.

[General Halla, I have heard of your reputation.]

I deliberately tried to speak to her. Unlike other Constellations, the 'Master of Baekrokdam' had not been one to cast a hostile gaze upon me.

As if to confirm this, Halla gazed deeply into my eyes and replied.

[Little Constellation of the peninsula, things have turned out badly.]

As expected.

Halla knew I was from the same peninsula.

Perhaps she'd heard the story from other Constellations, like the Goryeo Swordsman or the Maritime War God.

[Is your presence here something Hongik agreed to?]

[We Tamra do not seek Hongik's permission.]

[Why are you interfering in this? Wasn't Tamra a noble Constellation? Surely a Constellation like you wouldn't be aiming for the position of Seolmundae Halmang?]

Perhaps because I mentioned Seolmundae Halmang, a Mythical Constellation from Tamra? General Halla replied with a subtle expression.

[Child, I've heard rumors about you. Just as I've heard, you're quite the talker. I, too, would like to witness more of your story, but alas, time in this world doesn't allow it. Although your story ends here, your convictions will live on through the Shindansu.]

[Shut up, Halla. This tree will become the World Tree.]

Halla glared at Apollo with a slightly annoyed expression, then smiled gently at me and continued.

[Don't worry, we'll send you off in peace. We've prepared a special end for you.]

As General Halla raised her sword into the air, a cloud of probability appeared, gathering in the air like a dark cloud.

['Fate' is being recorded.]

Fate. The Nebula <Tamra> had directly influenced the Recorders.

「Kim Dokja will be absorbed into the 'Impossible Justice'—a Fear worthy of a genius.」

The word [Fate] was written with a great deal of probability. It seemed that the Recorder group known as 'Janggwang Library', who had previously bestowed [Fate] on me, had now joined forces with <Tamra Heavy Industry>.

[Halla, don't let your guard down. He has twisted 'Fate' before.]

[There's no need to worry about that. Our <Tamra> also staked its existence on this 'Fate'.]

As if certain that I could not change [Fate], a flicker of sympathy flashed across General Halla's eyes.

[Your Fate is about to be realized.]

The shadow of the tree grew slowly. The dark shadow covered the area, drawing everything in.

「This [Fate] is unavoidable.」

The fact that [Fate] was declared so quickly meant, though perhaps not, that the Grand Narrative of <Tamra> had been sacrificed to the realization of my fate.

All directions were surrounded by <Tamra>'s five hundred generals, <Olympus>, and the Constellations of <Asgard>, and my [Fate] was about to be realized.

I thought of my brother, who must have foreseen all this, and my other brothers who must have been watching.

How would they, Kim Dokja, have handled this situation?

What would be the most 'Kim Dokja-like' action right now?

[So you're asking me to be the sacrifice now? Right?]

The answer wasn't difficult.

[Good. Listen.]

General Halla smiled brightly, unsure of how she had perceived my words.

[Child of the Peninsula, <Tamra> rejoices in your sacrifice—]

[But if you're going to offer a sacrifice, wouldn't it be better if there were more?]

I took off my coat. Then I tore even the shirt I was wearing.

Stories dripped from the still-healing wound on my chest. From afar, I saw the Constellations' gazes change as they recognized my stories.

[I wonder how far your patience will go.]

Gripping my 'Unbreakable Faith', I made small cuts all over my upper body. As stories began to flow out in even greater quantities than before, the area soon became filled with the scent of my blood.

A Constellation took a step toward me.

[Wait. What are you all doing!]

I heard Apollo's bewildered cry, but the Constellations were already approaching me, as if possessed. When a story they desire is right before their eyes, there aren't many Constellations who can resist turning the page. That's why they're called Constellations.

I smiled at them and said,

[Why do you love 'stories' so much—]

Constellations.

Embracing the stories of incarnations they've never seen before, feeling angry, sad, happy, and willing to shine their light for them—

[Aren't you curious why?]

Beings who ultimately desire to become 'one' through a contract.

「The Constellations, having smelled the scent of the story, suddenly transformed and began to rush forward.」

General Halla, Apollo, and Vidar belatedly stepped in to stop them, but the situation was already out of control. In fact, their eyes were filled with desire.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', activates.]

It will be difficult for them to suppress their desires. Because—

[Halla. Apollo. Vidar.]

They've already tasted this story once.

[Come back. The story you desire is here.]

As the shadow of the tree spread across the area, the story my brother had bestowed upon them was reenacted on stage.

[The story, 'Star Communion', begins.]

In an instant, the Constellations rushed in, sinking their teeth into my torso like beasts. Even as I felt the story being torn away, I smiled and remained conscious.

[You ate my blood and flesh.]

The Constellations, belatedly regaining their senses, wavered in their eyes. Unable to laugh or cry, the Constellations, intoxicated by the story, groaned.

I looked down at them and said,

[Now we will share our fate.]

Soon, the shadow of the tree, now pitch-black, swallowed up all the starlight.

[Your 'Fate' will be realized.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 942 Episode 55 Giant Tree (8)

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I already anticipated they would use [Fate]. High-ranking Constellations always prefer to eliminate their enemies in a safe and secure manner.

「Kim Dokja will be absorbed by a Natural Disaster-level Fear—the 'Impossible Justice'.」

When [Fate] was unleashed, I had already separated my stories. I would feed the Constellations the stories I didn't need immediately, and take the ones I absolutely needed.

[The Constellation, 'Almighty Sun', requests 'Fate Revocation'!]

[The Constellation, 'Terminator of War', requests 'Fate Revocation'!]

[The Constellation, 'Master of Baekrokdam', requests 'Fate Revocation'!]

The Constellations that consumed my stories belatedly sent a message. However, contrary to their wishes, the [Fate] text would not change. Because,

[You are using the power of the 'Recorder of Fear'!]

[The 'Assistant Recorder' is sharing your record.]

I, too, was burdened with the probability of this [Fate].

All my Recorders' powers were aiding in the realization of [Fate], ensuring that the [Fate] bestowed upon me would not be scattered.

[All the Recorders of the 'Afterglow Library' are greatly alarmed!]

Normally, even if I had intervened, the Recorders would have somehow interfered with [Fate]. But this time, that was not possible. Because this [Fate] was bestowed upon me.

「I myself am strengthening the fate of my 'death'.」

Naturally, the entity with the greatest influence on the realization of 'death' through one's own will is oneself.

[The 'Afterglow Library' failed to reverse that 'Fate'!]

[The Constellation, 'Almighty Sun', trembles and cries out your name!]

Amidst the screaming of the Constellations, a familiar cry rang out.

"Dokja-ssi!"

I saw Jung Heewon reaching out to me. Her eyes, bloodshot as she finally grabbed my wrist, swept away.

"Hold on! Hold on tight!"

The tree's shadow sucked in all the starlight in the area, including me, but not Jung Heewon.

I held onto Jung Heewon tightly and spoke.

"Don't worry."

This [Fate] cannot be changed.

"Let's meet again."

At the last moment, my fingertips crumbled, and I saw the story blossoming from Jung Heewon's entire body.

「Disciple of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.」

As long as that story blossomed, this tree would not harm her.

[A Natural Disaster-level Fear, the 'Impossible Justice', receives the blessing of 'Fate.']

[You are Kim Dokja.]

Darkness enveloped my vision. In the deep darkness, I could faintly sense the presence of Constellations, drawn together. The Constellations floundered as if mired in a sticky swamp, constantly repeating their own stories.

[Why 'Fate'...!]

[Where are you all! What the heck is going on!]

Considering that higher-level Fears are classified as a type of Outer God, this tree could be considered a considerably high-ranking Outer God even among the 'Outer Deities'.

And the true nature of all 'Outer Deities' lies outside the scenario.

In other words, we, swallowed by this tree, were practically outside the scenario.

Tsutsutsutsutsu!

[The effect of 'Recorder of Fear' is activated!]

[You have strong probability immunity in 'Outside the Scenarios'.]

The Constellations, isolated from the 'Scenarios' for the first time since birth, were bewildered.

[Kaaaaaaah! Help! Apollo!]

The Constellations, accustomed to the abundant 'Scenario' pressure, were suddenly bloated, like creatures exposed to low pressure.

[No! No!]

The stories that had tightly wrapped around their bodies began to flow out.

「Eateateateat」

「Holdonholdonholdonholdon」

「Mythmythmythmythmythmyth」

Soon, the Constellations became indistinguishable from Outer Deities.

The shadows of the trees engulfed the Constellations, who had lost their selves and become like 'Nameless Things'. The tentacle-like shadows sucked in the brightly glowing stories.

[The 'Impossible Justice' begins to qualify as the 'World Tree.']

The starlight of the Constellations extinguished one by one, and I felt the tree's tentacles approaching me.

I spoke to the tree.

[Do you want to eat it?]

Losing my incarnation body here was a great blow to me. But I had the [Fourth Wall] and the story of the 'King of Fear'. At least as long as this world took on a form similar to the 'Fear Realm', I wouldn't die even if I were absorbed by this tree.

[Then try eating it.]

Indeed, the tree seemed to know this, observing me and not readily devouring me.

How much time had passed?

Soon, the tree's shadow, having made its decision, enveloped me.

[A Natural Disaster-level Fear, the 'Impossible Justice', absorbs you.]

I felt my incarnation body being sucked somewhere. Finally, I was entering the source of this 'Fear.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is activating!]

Protected by the [Fourth Wall], I maintained my consciousness, breathing slowly.

「"Listen, disciple. This is the most basic breathing technique to combat 'Fear'.」

A breathing technique Cheok Jungyeong once taught me.

It utilized 'story fragments', the first thing you acquire upon entering the Fear Realm.

[Story fragment, 'Fictionalization', continues its storytelling.]

To continue the 'story' to combat the infinitely expanding cosmic void. To cherish the relationships you've formed throughout your life.

Even if this entire history were nothing more than a fleeting dream fabricated by this universe—

「"Continuing that insignificant story is the only way we can endure this universe."」

With each breath, memories surfaced. This time, the people the master recalled were those he met in the 'Fear Realm'.

Cheok Jungyeong. Kyrgios. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. People who called me 'Kim End'.

What happened to the other Transcendents who rode the train? Is Kim Anna doing well?

What happened to Commander Cheonghuh, Deputy Commander Ryunard, and Deputy Commander Karlton?

And above all...

「...」

I heard a murmur from somewhere. Slowly opening my eyes, my five senses began to return one by one. The feeling of warm sunlight. The familiar air on my nose. The bustling chatter of people.

When I opened my eyes again, I found myself standing among the people walking along the street.

"Who did you say was participating in this 'Martial Arts Tournament'?"

A vaguely familiar sight.

I'd been here before. No, I knew this place even before I arrived.

"This time, perhaps..."

The streetscape I'd written about, read about, and experienced.

「This is the 'First Murim Tournament'.」

A place that no longer existed in the 41st Round. A world destroyed with the birth of the 'New Murim'.

That world was preserved within Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's tree.

「To properly interpret Fear, we must understand its underlying theme.」

I calmly surveyed the streets. Even within the same 'First Murim', not all 'First Murims' of the 'Ways of Survival' were 'the same place'.

This tree's name was the 'Impossible Justice'.

Considering that the name of a Fear embodies its underlying theme, a clue to its interpretation must also be hidden somewhere within this memory.

「What was the 'Impossible Justice' that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint dreamed of?」

But no matter how much I searched the streets, nothing seemed to offer a clue.

Come to think of it, I didn't know much about Breaking the Sky Sword Saint to begin with.

That she was half-breed of the Giants. That she was revered as a god of Murim. That she pursued fair and just justice above all else... This kind of information wasn't necessarily mine; it was something everyone in Murim knew.

"...Huh?"

A faint aroma of food wafted from somewhere. A Murim specialty I knew well.

「Murim dumplings.」

As I inhaled the fragrant aroma of dumplings, I briefly felt the urge to forget all Fear and just eat some dumplings.

Led by the smell, I took a few steps forward and saw a group of people lying like vagrants near a long-established dumpling shop. Most were martial arts practitioners who had been expelled from their sects, or had their martial arts skills stripped away and their dantian destroyed.

They had lost hope in the scenario and were stuck to this street like weeds.

"Get out of here. This is my place."

Even in the world of weeds, there were strong and weak. The vagrants were picking up dumplings someone had dropped, and they were fighting over the crumbs.

I watched the vagrants' struggle for a moment, thinking.

「No Fear exists without a reason.」

Vagabonds attacked each other for various reasons. Some because they were one-armed, others because they were missing an eye.

In this world of martial arts, the 'weak' meant being different. Some could be weak, others because they were too big or too small.

"Damn that giant-tribe bitch."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was a member of the Namgung family, but had long been persecuted by the family simply because she was half-breed of the giant-tribe.

So, did she want to seek a compromise for the 'weak'?

[A Natural Disaster-level Fear, an 'Impossible Justice' is watching you.]

Considering her 'fairness', it wasn't an absurd thought.

But was that really the only reason Breaking the Sky Sword Saint became 'Fear'?

Even if she was a 'god of Murim', was there any reason why her motives had to be divine?

"Mmm, delicious."

"As expected, these are the dumplings of Murim."

Even so, watching the people waiting in line to get dumplings, I truly wanted to put my fear aside and just eat a dumpling...

[The Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', gleamed with curiosity.]

Startled by the message coming from the air, I looked around.

Uriel?

But I quickly shook my head.

This world was within the memories of 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint'.

If that's the case, then that indirect message must also be Uriel's, written in the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's memories.

But was there anyone in this 'First Murim' who could catch Uriel's attention?

"You son of a bitch! That's my scraps!"

"He's going to eat them!"

Just then, a shout came from somewhere. I turned around and saw the vagrants who had been vying for space were lynching another vagrant.

[The Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', looks at the unfamiliar incarnation with pitiful eyes.]

The man, badly beaten, was thrown to the ground.

I walked toward him, as if drawn by the smell of dumplings.

Even in the midst of the lynching, the man held onto the dumpling wrapper clutched in his hand.

The moment I saw that rough, familiar hand, a phrase from 'Ways of Survival' came to mind.

「There are people in this world who are handsome from the back of their heads.」

Come to think of it, there was only one reason why the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint would choose to be 'Fear'.

A variety of emotions surged and then subsided simultaneously.

I slowly crouched down, looked down at him, and spoke.

"Are you hungry?"

Eight years later, I hadn't seen the back of his head, and it still looked like I wanted to punch him.

"Joonghyuk-ah."

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 943 Episode 55 Giant Tree (9)

My heart froze at the words I'd thrown at him. Joonghyuk-ah. I don't call Yoo Joonghyuk that.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', chuckles at you.]

Is this because I've absorbed so much of 'Kim Dokja's' story?

I couldn't tell. Is what I feel when I see Yoo Joonghyuk his? Or mine?

Or perhaps both?

Even though I knew my words wouldn't be conveyed, I spoke to Yoo Joonghyuk again.

"The dumpling you're holding."

I wouldn't normally do this.

This scene was recreated through the memories of Breaking the Sky Sword Master. I couldn't, and shouldn't, interfere with these memories.

"You'll definitely get a stomachache if you eat it."

The Yoo Joonghyuk before me wasn't the Yoo Joonghyuk I'd spent the '41st Round' with. The description of 'Ways of Survival' flowing through my mind revealed to me who Yoo Joonghyuk was before me.

「That day, Yoo Joonghyuk was terribly hungry.」

This was a story from a time when the title of Supreme King wasn't yet fitting.

「It had been a long time since he'd felt so hungry. He had to eat something. To live and move, to not die here. Even if it wasn't something he made, he had to eat and survive.」

Looking at the dried dumpling wrapper in his hand, I felt the sentences in my head vividly replayed before my eyes.

「That damned Prophet—Anna Croft said. Go here. If you go here, you'll find the clue to saving the world.」

Yoo Joonghyuk's early Rounds, as poignant as the dried dumpling wrapper, were right here.

「We need the strength to defeat the Holy Chaos. We must be equipped to fight against those damned high beings.」

Gods who far surpass human limitations. Yoo Joonghyuk sought Anna Croft's advice to defeat them, and, as a 'mortal', arrived in the 'First Murim' in search of the power to slay the Constellations.

「A 'Transcendent' is here.」

A legendary mortal said to bring down even the stars in the sky. Learning of its existence, Yoo Joonghyuk set out to find its traces in the 'First Murim'.

「"Anyone who knows about the Transcendent, come forward. I'll buy any information about it."」

Along the way, he experiences trial and error, makes foolish moves, and is even deceived by the Black Knights.

「"Yoo Joonghyuk-ssi, this is the martial art of the Transcendent."」

Anyway, Yoo Joonghyuk, who has committed only foolish acts in the early Rounds, ends up stripped of his possessions, a beggar, and living on the streets of the 'First Murim'.

"But do you really have to eat those dumplings?"

Even after hearing my advice, Yoo Joonghyuk refused to give up the stale dumplings. I sighed lightly. I knew. This was Yoo Joonghyuk. A Regressor who defied his predetermined fate head-on. If the dumplings he was about to eat were rotten, he would train and train himself until he could eat them without dying. That was him.

「Even if this is a recreated memory, wouldn't it be okay to trade a dumpling for something like that?」

The moment I reached out to him, a huge shadow covered us. A chill that blotted out even the hot sunlight. Startled, I raised my head and saw a tall martial artist standing there.

She passed me by and approached Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You're a very handsome guy."

Watching the slowly moving scenery, I realized the significance of this moment anew.

Perhaps Breaking the Sky Sword Saint—the 'Impossible Justice'—had wanted to show me this moment.

「This was the source of this 'Fear'.」

It wasn't anger toward the Constellations or hatred for the humans who persecuted her that led her to choose to become this 'World Tree'.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, with a giant hand, grabbed Yoo Joonghyuk by the scruff of the neck and asked,

"Are you hungry?"

This conversation began simply to feed a dumpling to her disciple, exhausted from prolonged starvation.

「That was the first meeting between Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and Yoo Joonghyuk in the Second Round.」

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Intermittent explosions. The screams of the incarnations who had entered <Tamra Heavy Industry>.

Kyung Sein and Namgung Myung were hiding in this chaotic landscape, watching the Constellations occupying the <Tamra Heavy Industry> area.

"CEO, is the Benefactor alright?"

Five hours had already passed since Kim Dokja and Jung Heewon entered the <Tamra Heavy Industry> headquarters.

[The 'Destruction Scenario' is currently in progress.]

A scenario where they strip each other of their 'Tribute' and take it away, that scenario was suddenly transformed by the appearance of a single tree.

"CEO."

Kyung Sein didn't respond to Namgung Myung's call. She was staring at the tree of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

[A Natural Disaster-level Fear, the 'Impossible Justice', is taking root in the area.]

The area around <Tamra Heavy Industries> was covered in a lush forest, and the vines that stretched out were soon reaching the headquarters of other companies.

"Kwaaaaah! Run away!"

"I'll eat you!"

In just a few more hours, the 'First Murim', would be obliterated by that tree. That single tree would eventually form a forest, growing endlessly and becoming the source of a new universe.

"CEO, we must move now. The incarnations are gathering on the southern planet."

Kyung Sein looked toward the southern planet. Incarnations who didn't belong to any corporation were gathering. Those who couldn't be chosen by the major corporations or collect the Tribute necessary for Ascension.

"All fellow practitioners of Murim, gather together! The time has come to protect our 'Murim' together!"

"Let's go save Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

Our Murim. Kyung Sein couldn't quite remember the last time she'd heard such an expression. It still felt strange that such incarnations existed in this city.

"Why aren't they all running away?"

Ascension wasn't the only escape route. The incarnations could have survived if they had made a pact with another sacred being or Nebula and fled to another 'Constellation context', or even took refuge in the area where the former 'Fear Realm' once stood.

But the incarnations didn't do so. Those who had previously coveted each other's Tribute were simply joining forces to confront the advent of a disaster that threatened to destroy Murim.

[Natural Disaster-level Fear, 'Impossible Justice', stares at the 'New Murim'.]

Perhaps this was the effect of Fear. The tree's appearance had awakened a certain agreement long forgotten by the martial artists.

Even Namgung Myung's eyes had been flickering with a faint heat for some time.

"They've designated this place as their ■■."

"■■?"

"Everyone can choose where they die, right?"

"Dying here would be a waste of time, you know that."

Kyung Sein continued, her voice strangely agitated.

"This is no longer a scenario we should intervene in. Soon, the Nebulae will appear, and a war will break out over that tree. There's no room for certainty in that."

"…"

"You and the people are now ruled by Fear. That Fear is forcing false beliefs upon you."

This situation was clearly abnormal. Just moments ago, those who had been collecting Tribute and aiming for Ascension were now gathering with one heart and one mind. For the sole purpose of protecting this city, now a city with nothing left to protect, even its name meaningless.

"If this is the effect of Fear, then that's not a bad thing. If only intoxicated by this Fear could I, and the people, find the courage to do so."

"Such courage..."

"I know, CEO."

A light flashed from a corner of the sky. For a moment, Namgung Myung's face, backlit, looked strangely distorted.

"The 'Murim' we are to protect no longer exists. Is that what you mean?"

[The 'Sangwanggo' Recorders are interfering with the records of the area.]

The stories left by the Recorders of Fear were blossoming beneath Seoul. One by one, the protagonists of these stories were appearing in Murim.

[The Constellations of <Asgard> gaze upon the area.]

[The Constellations of <Vedas> gaze upon the area.]

[The Constellations of <Olympus> gaze upon the area.]

The Constellations, sensing the emergence of the World Tree, finally began to exert their influence on the battlefield.

Tamra, in particular, had deployed its main force, dominating the skies of the battlefield with a truly terrifying ferocity.

Kyung Sein had also heard of their formation.

「The Five Hundred Generals of <Tamra>.」

As the massive force of the Nebula, rarely seen even in grand scenarios, gathered, the night of Murim became as bright as day.

「A magnificent 'Giant Story' rarely encountered even once in a lifetime.」

Namgung Myung added in a trembling voice amidst the spectacle of the stars.

"It might be a fool's demise, as you say, CEO. It's entirely possible that I, and the other martial artists, will simply be swept away by the emergence of the 'Giant Story'. But if

this is the final story of Murim, then even this ending isn't so bad. Humans eventually die, don't they?"

Humans eventually die. Faced with that obvious truth, Namgung Myung's eyes shone as brightly as the sacred fire of the heavens. An expression only someone who has accepted their own fate and prepared for the end of their story can wear.

「Perhaps this is the final gift from 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' to the martial artists.」

The god of Murim, who loved Murim, offered these incarnations the final opportunity to live as 'martial artists'.

"I want to be recorded as a legendary tale."

Given this opportunity, Namgung Myung continued.

"My Murim has already ended once. Rather, it feels like this is the opportunity to write again."

At that moment, Kyung Sein realized. This man, these people, weren't tainted by Fear. They truly knew.

「They chose this scenario as their final stage.」

Kyung Sein, as if in protest, said, "What's the point? It's just a story. It's just a story. What's the point of writing it down—"

"A story is something you tell someone someday. Damn it."

Kyung Sein was stunned by Namgung Myung's unexpected words.

"I want to personally create the image of 'Murim' that will be etched into the stars."

Kyung Sein knew the people who had said such things.

「"Yes, perhaps I might fail."」

The companions left her here and went off in search of the next scenario.

「"But he'll understand. He'll read the story he loves, telling him that we lived to the end. That's enough."」

Namgung Myung asked, his expression identical to that of her companions back then.

"How about you, CEO?"

"…"

"I understand you stayed here alone when the other corporate leaders left. What did you want to prove, CEO?"

What was she still here to prove?

Enduring a faint wave of dizziness, Kyung Sein spoke.

"I wasn't here to prove anything in particular."

Head down, she continued, squeezing out the words.

"When all my colleagues left for the higher-level scenarios, I was outwardly angry, but secretly happy."

Here, she wouldn't have to take risks. She wouldn't have to venture out, and she wouldn't have to face the terrifying Constellations.

"The others probably knew too. That I didn't want to fight. That's probably why no one asked me to come with them."

Snowfield Kim Dokja said.

「"Someday, 'he' will appear again in the scenario. Then tear this paper."」

From then on, her role was set.

When a new Kim Dokja appeared here, she would tear the transmission slip and notify 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

She reached into her pocket and held the transmission slip she had received that day. The texture of the cold, soft paper. Feeling its alluring texture, Kyung Sein confessed,

"I'm a coward. I don't have any grand convictions or great causes. I can't risk my life for such things. I can pretend, but I've never truly done so."

If she tore this slip, her mission would be accomplished. 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' would keep his promise, and she would be able to escape this story.

"I want to live. Just surviving—that's my only goal."

She would be able to return to the universe where all of this was fiction, as if nothing had happened.

"You'll despise me. You'll call me a coward without courage. You'll think there's no point in trying to survive like that."

Instead of answering, Namgung Myung paused for a moment, observing the battlefield. A few minutes passed before he spoke again.

"I once heard a story from the Constellations that were after D-Coins. They say there's a very old god in this universe who loves stories, and he dreams of all the stories of the universe."

Kyung Sein raised her head.

Namgung Myung continued.

"I don't have any religious beliefs, but after hearing that story, I briefly thought it would be nice if such a god existed. It means that even if I live a mediocre life, at least one person is watching over me."

From a distance, the lush forest swayed. Kyung Sein muttered to herself, blending the forest's noise with her own.

"I wonder if that god is watching me, too?"

"I don't know for sure, but if such a god exists..."

Namgung Myung said, slowly walking toward the southern Earth.

"I, too, would like to make a slightly more interesting choice for that god."

Namgung Myung turned and walked away, leaving Kyung Sein alone. Pulling the transmission unit from her pocket, Kyung Sein stared down at the blank piece of paper.

Just tearing the paper.

Perhaps it was a simple task. Yet, why couldn't she do such an easy task?

「She felt like there was more to be written on this piece of paper she had to tear.」

Having read this story only once, did she have the right to wonder what would happen next?

Perhaps she, too, was overcome by fear. But in that moment, Kyung Sein was certain. If Kim Dokja were reading this story, she would be recorded like this.

「Kyung Sein didn't tear the transmission unit.」

Having made up her mind, everything became clear. The death she had so feared felt as light as a single line in a story.

I must help Kim Dokja. I must go to that forest.

And at that moment, the transmission unit glowed brightly, and words appeared on the paper.

「"As expected, you made that choice."」

Kyung Sein's eyes widened in surprise. Though she couldn't hear the voice, she knew immediately whose writing it was.

Kim Dokja, who had given his story to the Constellations and built this 'New Murim'.

Snowfield Kim Dokja was speaking to her.

「"It seems you've chosen the 'Kim Dokja' you desire, so I'll ask you now."」

Kyung Sein's hands trembled. Snowfield Kim Dokja had known from the beginning that she wouldn't tear up the transmission unit.

So, what purpose did this 'transmission unit' serve?

「"Sein-ssi."」

In the distance, the forest began to glow brightly. The final chapter of this scenario was finally about to begin.

「"Are you truly willing to risk your life for a 'story you've read once'?"」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 944 Episode 55 Giant Tree (10)

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I accompanied Yoo Joonghyuk on his second round of swordsmanship in the memories of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. I saw Yoo Joonghyuk sweating profusely, repeatedly slashing every day.

Watching Yoo Joonghyuk practice his swordsmanship while being beaten on the butt by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, I suddenly remembered the first time I learned swordsmanship from Kirgios.

Of course, Kirgios didn't hit my butt like Breaking the Sky Sword Saint (if he had, he would have recorded it), but he didn't spare specific insults to 'large creatures' whenever I made a mistake.

Perhaps both Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and Kirgios learned from the same teacher, so their teaching methods were similar.

「Memories were like sentences with the occasional conjunction missing.」

Some memories flowed quickly, others slowly. Perhaps this is what Yoo Joonghyuk remembers—and the stories Breaking the Sky Sword Saint read. This tree was showing me that story once again.

"Go to Changcheonbong Peak in the <First Murim> and pick a white rhododendron."

Yoo Joonghyuk's journey to master [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship],

"Jang Bodo has appeared in the <Fourth Murim>. It's the 'Secret Land of Master Hyeonhak'. Enter the secret land and retrieve the elixir left behind by the master."

At the orders of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, he went to Changcheonbong Peak, visited Master Hyeonhak's secret land, and visited the Demon Cult.

"Go to the Demon Cult of the <Third Murim> and retrieve the Everlasting Ice. It's been so hot lately, I haven't felt the motivation to teach martial arts."

Most of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's requests were absurd, but Yoo Joonghyuk readily carried out her outrageous orders.

"Go to Shaolin and steal the Daehandan. Beware of the Ddaengjung."

I also saw Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been captured and rendered bald by the greatest Shaolin monk, Shin Seung. Seeing that Yoo Joonghyuk in person was a remarkable experience, but it didn't make me laugh.

While Yoo Joonghyuk was going through all that, I could do nothing. All I could do was keep my eyes wide open, trying not to miss a single moment of the memories he had experienced and the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had preserved.

After watching their story intently, I realized why Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had entrusted Yoo Joonghyuk with such a tiresome mission.

Every life is precious because it's only once. Once a choice is made, it never comes back, and it becomes a story.

But what about Yoo Joonghyuk?

For him, who can change his choices countless times, what meaning does life have?

「He climbed Changcheonbong Peak for the first time and saw a starless landscape.」

Seeing the empty sky for the first time in a world plagued by the gaze of the stars.

「In the secret realm of Master Hyeonhak, he encountered a divine being who saved people.」

Witnessing the symbiosis that exists in Murim of Dosan Geomrim.

Yoo Joonghyuk carried out the orders of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, discovering scenes he had previously missed in the world of scenarios.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

And in the process...

"Why?"

"No."

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk gained a better understanding of the world he sought to save.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint taught Yoo Joonghyuk 'the way to survive'.」

Living means connecting with this world, forming connections. Saving someone and being saved again.

For the Regressor, who, in his quest to save this world, lived a life unrelated to its people, that experience was essential.

「And so spring passed, and summer passed.」

Time can be short, or long. It can be written in a single sentence, or even a book. They spent such time together—

「Autumn came, and winter came.」

Finally, they became master and disciple.

「The end of the second round was drawing near.」

Snow was falling from the sky.

Perhaps this would be the last winter of the second round that Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and Yoo Joonghyuk would spend together.

I sat on the veranda next to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, watching Yoo Joonghyuk practice his sword.

Breaking the Sky God. Yoo Joonghyuk, shirtless even in the middle of winter, swinging his sword. Watching the sweat that had formed in his veins crystallize and drip down, I thought of Kim Dokja.

「I wish this story would never end.」

Sometimes, knowing the ending of a story can be painful. Even knowing that it would ultimately end in tragedy, Kim Dokja read it again and again.

And like Yoo Joonghyuk, who struggled to save the world, Kim Dokja must have constantly considered the possibility that this story wouldn't end in tragedy.

「Since every sentence is already written, all the reader can do is fathom its meaning.」

Just as Yoo Joonghyuk ultimately couldn't reach the ending he desired, Kim Dokja also faced the same tragedy time and time again.

Faced with a predetermined tragedy, all humans can do is explore its meaning. To somehow prove that this entire world wasn't meaningless.

If Yoo Joonghyuk's job was to fight the world, Kim Dokja's job was to fight meaninglessness.

"What are you thinking about?"

I wondered if it was because I was so lost in thought. When Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, sitting next to me, spoke, I quickly looked up.

"I asked you what you were thinking about."

Only then did I realize Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was asking me.

The question, "Since when—" flashed through my mind, but that wasn't the point.

This world of memory was realized by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

It was only natural that she discovered me, intruding into her memories.

"I was thinking you were a truly sad person."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint turned her head and looked at me. Sensing her gaze, I continued speaking.

"You must have been watching this landscape alone for a very long time."

Snow must have fallen in her world for a long time. Recalling this landscape, she must have searched for clues her disciple hadn't discovered in the previous round.

"You must have seen this world countless times."

"But it only happened once. There's no turning back, no turning back."

That's right. We reread that one-time story over and over again. Reading it, we live our lives anew.

"Did you know I was coming?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint nodded slightly and replied.

"I heard your story from the Outer Gods of the Fear Realm."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint didn't stay in the Fear Realm with me. She only participated in the final battle, so she wasn't fully aware of what I had done in the Fear Realm.

"What were they talking about?"

"They said you seemed like someone who wanted to embrace every story in the world."

I pondered that for a moment before replying.

"I'm no one like that. I just write what I want to write and read what I want to read."

"In the stories you want to read."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint turned her head again, looked at Yoo Joonghyuk, and added,

"Is that child included?"

I paused for a moment before answering.

"Yes."

It was a confident answer, surprising even myself. I didn't even have to wonder if it was Kim Dokja's or mine. Perhaps, at that moment, every Kim Dokja in the world was thinking the same thing.

Listening to the soft falling snow, I asked Breaking the Sky Sword Saint,

"Is there something you'd like to ask me?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was now an Outer God, and she must have learned some of the secrets of this world, and perhaps even understood her own fate and that of her disciple. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's lips moved slightly, as if shaking a giant tree.

"How many more regressions will my disciple experience?"

I couldn't readily answer. Perhaps I could have said something like this:

「"Your disciple will experience 1,863 regressions. And on the 1,864th, he will finally reach his desired ending."」

But was that really the future that 'that Yoo Joonghyuk' would experience?

The Breaking the Sky Sword Saint before me was the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint of the '41st' round, and the Yoo Joonghyuk she spoke of was the Yoo Joonghyuk of the '41st'.

"That guy..."

And I already knew what kind of end Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round would meet—what he would lose at the end of this world.

"He's failing, isn't he?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint spoke, her voice laced with deep sadness.

"Even after enduring such a terribly long time, he can never find happiness."

"I don't know yet."

I bit my lip, as if erasing a sentence already written, then opened my mouth again.

As she had said, the ending of the 41st round had already been written. But—

"I came here to rewrite this story."

Only after I had said it out loud did I realize how desperately I had longed for it.

"I will do whatever it takes to make that guy reach his desired ending."

"Even if that ending ends in failure?"

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

I met Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's piercing eyes. The power of chaos pulsated within her clear, ethereal eyes.

Feeling the tingling energy of the Outer God suffocating my entire body, I managed to speak.

"I know why you became a 'tree'."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had been with Yoo Joonghyuk's life, more intimately than anyone else.

She was a mortal who understood others' emotions better than anyone else. Unlike Yoo Joonghyuk, whose emotions gradually wore away with each round, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint must have had to relearn the past rounds of 'A Newly Encountered Disciple' with each round.

And she must have had to accept that her disciple had already been her disciple forty times, and that she had lost him forty times.

Therefore, the reason she became 'Fear' is simple.

"You don't want your disciple to suffer from 'stories' anymore."

The Constellations said it. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint absorbed the D-coins herself.

The meaning was simple.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint chose to sacrifice herself and become the 'World Tree'.」

I continued, watching the stories flowing from her body.

"The stories of this world—all scenarios—are created through 'conflict'."

Since the constellations love conflict, all scenarios are born from it.

"Conversely, if 'conflict' disappears from this world, the scenarios will disappear."

All characters who seek to prevent the world's tragedy share similarities.

The Second Kim Dokja opened the 'Fear Realm' for the forgotten, ultimately attempting to turn the entire world into a 'Fear Realm'.

To protect those he loved, he 'killed' everyone around him.

Han Sooyoung, who had been created as an 'avatar' in the 1,863rd round, and Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who now forces an 'Impossible Justice' on all beings, were the same.

Even now, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's tree is probably covering the 'New Murim District' in real time. Having grown by devouring everything in the city, it will soon break through the upper scenarios and engulf the <Star Stream>.

Finally, the tree, which has become a single world, will impose only one 'consensus' on its forest.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

The foreign narrative flowing from Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's body began to intensify.

There stood the master, who had grown from the tragedy of her disciple. Her disciple, who had dedicated his life to saving the world, but ultimately failed.

There was only one thing the master could do for her disciple.

"Are you planning to destroy all 'scenarios' in the <Star Stream> for Yoo Joonghyuk?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 945 Episode 55 Giant Tree (11)

Her silence was soon a confirmation.

As expected, she was an Outer God, intent on destroying this Star Stream.

"Do you think it's a proper conclusion for you to be the first to yearn for that world, just because your disciple will despair of it?"

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint looked at me silently and then withdrew.

"Do you think this world is worth protecting? Do you believe that the <Star Stream>, which uses all existence as mere material for narrative, is still worth continuing?"

Kim Dokja once said something similar. When Anna Croft asked if he, too, was fighting to protect this world, Kim Dokja replied,

"We'll have to wait and see whether this world is truly worth protecting."

But even Kim Dokja ultimately chose not to destroy the <Star Stream>.

Neither the gawking of the Constellations nor the cruelty of the scenarios were reasons to destroy this world.

Perhaps Kim Dokja had concluded: despite all the tragedy, this world was worth preserving. Even in a world where aspirations were firmly established, meaning still existed.

"Yes."

Accepting tragedy.

"Because this damned world exists, so does your disciple."

Calmly reading the already written sentences and moving forward.

"And that world, that guy never gave up on it."

In some worldline, Yoo Joonghyuk might have given up on his mission. Han Sooyoung is telling the story. She might not have continued writing, and Kim Dokja might not have been interested in 'Ways of Survival'.

But at least in the worldline I know, things were different.

Han Sooyoung wrote 'Ways of Survival', Kim Dokja read it, and Yoo Joonghyuk lived his life to the end.

There were Constellations who loved that story. The faint starlight gathered to reveal the ending, and a story that didn't exist in the original was born.

Perhaps the laws of this universe can change just a little bit like that. I believe in that possibility.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. Stop the expansion of the tree. Your disciple is not as weak as you think."

Facing the radiant Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's 'Mirror Vision', I continued my story.

"Do not destroy the <Star Stream>. If you completely become a Fear, you will lose your sense of self. Having lost your sense of self, you will lose control of the world to the nebulae, and ultimately, this forest will become a playground for the Constellations. The scenario won't end with 'a single justice', as you think."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint must know this. The ending she desires won't come. In this world, where everything, as she always does, becomes the subject of a story, even her justice is merely part of the story.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint raised her head and looked up at the sky.

"The Constellations are gathering outside the forest."

"I know."

The Constellations' intentions were clear. They would uproot this giant tree, beyond their control. They would then take it to the higher scenarios and use it as a breakwater for the great apocalypse.

"I'm not afraid of the Constellations."

I've already seen the end of worldlines several times. I've seen the endings Kim Dokja showed, Cheon Inho showed, and Han Sooyoung showed.

I know the new school Constellations are powerful. I know how distant the stories that drive them are, and how foolish it is to fight against them.

But in the 1,863rd round, the Apocalypse Dragon appeared. Even when I descended, and when Yoo Joonghyuk died in the 40th round, everyone said the same thing: this story is over. But neither Han Sooyoung nor Cheon Inho gave up, and they reached a conclusion even Yoo Joonghyuk couldn't see.

"If you don't give up, you can definitely fight back."

Instead of answering my words, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint gazed silently at the winter sky. A faint crack of light was forming across the pitch-black night. The Constellations were attempting to infiltrate this 'tree'.

[Sad Recorder of the stars.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's Mirror Vision Eyes looked at me, and I looked back at her. Our story resonated, and the surrounding scenery began to change.

[I ask you if you have the strength to prove your justice.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's manor vanished. The expansive veranda vanished. The barking cries of the Breaking the Sky Sword Master and Yoo Joonghyuk's swordsmanship slicing through the air dispersed.

What unfolded before me was a bloody battlefield. I knew this stage well.

「This was the 'final battle site' of the second round's Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.」

I saw the returnees lying on the ground. Martial arts practitioners who had returned from other worlds. Those who had gained strength from other worlds and descended as disasters to seek revenge on this 'Murim'.

「Returnee War.」

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had single-handedly prevented disaster here and protected Murim.

A powerful aura emanated from Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's body. I could feel the power of an Outer being enveloping her entire being.

[Natural Disaster-level Fear, 'Impossible Justice', is watching you.]

It felt like staring into an endless abyss. The Breaking the Sky Sword Saint standing before me was the same being who had emerged from the bushes earlier and blocked Jung Heewon.

[What is your justice?]

A golden aura rippled from her hand, then took the form of a sword.

Breaking the Sky Divine Sword.

Since no metal in this Murim could fully withstand her story, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had forged her own story to create a sword. She said.

「A sword abandoned to cut down the stars in the sky.」

Later, the Meteor Shower, created by Yoo Joonghyuk, also applied the supernatural power of the Breaking the Sky God.

To counter the immense fighting spirit emanating from her body, I, too, drew up my magical power. The flowing magical power naturally blended with my mantra.

[My justice is.]

As I slowly inhaled, the story within me began to speak.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins its storytelling.]

This forest grants strength to those who uphold their principles. Therefore, I, too, must have a duty to prove my principles here.

「What is my justice?」

I lack the upright convictions of Kim Dokja, the grand ambitions of Han Sooyoung, or the tenacious persistence of Yoo Joonghyuk.

[My justice is—]

Nevertheless, even I, like you, have a vision I long to see.

[A world where Yoo Joonghyuk can eat 'dumplings made by others' with peace of mind.]

The flying Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. Slashing her blade with all my might, I continued my mantra.

[People who love one person's story—living together in the 'Big House' they desire.]

'Unbreakable Faith' shone brightly. The giant story contained in the swordplay was pushing back the power of the outside world.

[It's to ensure that those who still refuse to give up on their stories—won't be saddened by their story's ending.]

[Your 'giant story' responds to your will.]

Han Sooyoung said. The 'Giant Story' I possess responds to the 'story I want to write'.

Perhaps, on the day this 'Giant Story' becomes a 'Super Giant Story', the world I long to see will also meet its end.

Kagagagagak!

We exchanged sword strikes in silence. Despite the help of the 'Giant Story', I was slowly falling behind. This was partly because my proficiency in the 'Giant Story' wasn't high, and partly because Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, who had become a 'Outer God', was an entity outside the standard.

Within this 'forest', her status was... A level approaching Mythical.

Having been devoured by the stories, unable to smoothly activate either the 'Demon King of Salvation' or the 'King of Fear' mode, she was an unbeatable opponent for me.

Nevertheless, I persisted and swung my sword because I knew from the start she wouldn't harm me.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.

Great Move.

Breaking the Sky Meteor Shower.

A meteor shower, destined to knock down the stars, descended upon me. I used [Way of the Wind] to dodge the trajectories and advance forward.

「To write and read this 'world' presented before me to the end.」

At present, I can neither freely wield the stories of the 'Demon King of Salvation' nor the power of the 'King of Fear'. But even I, a mere mortal, can do something.

「"Believe in the stories you've built. What you've experienced is who you are. Your job is to give meaning to that story, to give it a name."」

This was the power of the stories I had purely accumulated.

With the overflowing energy of the 'Giant Tale', [Bookmark] and [Incite] simultaneously activated in my mind.

「"I am 'Kyrgios Rodgraim'."」

I saw Breaking the Sky Sword Saint hesitate for a moment as she confirmed the lightening of [Electrification] surging through my body.

[That ability—]

For a moment, I became electric, retracing the Meteor Shower's trajectory and arriving right in front of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. The moment her eyes widened, 'Unbreakable Faith' stirred. [Way of the Wind] exploded like a howling wolf, and the electric wave of [Baekcheong-ganggi] pierced through the gap created by the explosion.

The blades pierced like solid fangs. Something ripped deeply, and only after passing Breaking the Sky Sword Saint a dozen steps did I finally stop. As the power of [Electrification] dispersed, a faint sense of exhaustion washed over me.

When I turned around, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was still standing tall. Silvery wisps of light were fluttering before her.

[Who taught you this technique?]

This technique, a fusion of the powers of [Way of the Wind] and [Electrification], was something I mastered while studying under Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd round.

「Wind Wolf Slash and White Wolf Slash.」

[I learned it from everyone I met.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint seemed to ponder something for a while after hearing my answer, then said,

[I have seen your justice.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint slowly turned, her wounds already healed. Wind Wolf Slash and White Wolf Slash were techniques I had practiced to cut down even the most stellar Constellations with a single stroke, but as expected, they were no match for Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

A lump in my throat twitched as I watched Breaking the Sky Sword Saint slowly approach. In the end, I wondered if I should use the story of the 'King of Fear'.

[Stand back, young Recorder.]

As Breaking the Sky Sword Saint uttered her mantra, a single flash of light pierced the sky. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint swung her sword toward the sky as if protecting me. Breaking the Sky Divine Sword, which had deflected the flash, let out a soft sword sound.

Frowning, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint raised her head and saw Murim’s sky shatter like broken glass. Constellations emerged from the cracks of scattered light.

[Found it.]

They were Constellations I knew well.

I'd clearly seen the stories swallowed by the tree, but it seemed only a small number were destroyed that way.

The number of Constellations appearing on the battlefield easily exceeded three hundred.

[The possibility of a 'Giant Story' is stirring in the scenario.]

A battlefield so large that the likelihood of a 'Giant Tale' scenario was building.

The three Constellations that occupied its center were the aforementioned three.

[This is our chance to seize the core of the World Tree.]

Apollo, Vidar, and Halla.

The three Constellations, having taken my brother's story and reached the border of Mythical Constellations, radiated a bright light, glaring at me and Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

Apollo glared coldly at me, then turned to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint and commanded the Constellations.

[Take care of them.]

The Five Hundred Generals of <Tamra> moved. Each of them was enough to cause disaster to a small planet. They were all simultaneously revealing their power to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

The first Constellation to land on the ground roared and swung their massive spear at Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint gazed at the Constellations with indifferent eyes and opened her mouth.

[With such a mere justice.]

The Constellation's spear shattered like a toy.

[You intend to face me?]

The moment the general's eyes widened, his neck was already flying through the air. It was a speed too fast for the naked eye to detect.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint hasn't been using her full strength until now.」

I had a vague sense of it, but even so, the goosebumps on the back of my neck wouldn't stop. The true power of a Natural Disaster-level Fear was awakening within Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's entire body.

[Don't back down! That bastard—]

Before he could even utter his mantra, the Constellation was torn in two. No one could block her sword.

「Why does the 'First Murim' worship the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' as a god?」

The answer was right before my eyes.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, transformed into an Outer God and the very embodiment of fear, had finally become Fear itself, achieving the stranglehold of the stars she had longed for.

[Did you really intend to listen to my story with such a justice?]

With each swing of the sword, the stars in the sky went out one by one. Stars that had lost their lore crumbled and shattered, and the terrified Five Hundred Generals retreated, unable to hide their shock.

「They chose the wrong battlefield.」

This is the world of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

Unless even a Myth-level Constellation descends, there's no way to deal with her.

Currently, there are no Myth-level Constellations in the Great Nebula to dispatch here.

[Ah, Apollo! Vidar!]

[Kuaaaaak! Get out of the way!]

Common sense dictated that Apollo, Vidar, and Halla should have acknowledged their shortcomings and retreated.

But they did not retreat.

[It's true that some 'Fears' are comparable to 'Myth-level' ones.]

With a seemingly intriguing remark, Apollo from the sky landed on the ground. Halla and Vidar followed.

Apollo opened his mouth with a faint smile.

[I have a gift prepared for you, foolish forest god.]

A faint sound, like a scream, could be heard from afar. Listening closely, I realized it was a story.

[The story, 'Returnee War', begins its storytelling.]

A trembling, sorrowful story. The moment I realized the story's true identity, goosebumps ran down my spine.

At that moment, I realized where I was. This was the final stage of the second round. The final battlefield of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint of the second round will die here, under the combined attack of the Heavenly Demon and the Blood Demon.」

['Staging' begins!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 946 Episode 55 Giant Tree (12)

Amidst the undulating scenery, 「Staging」 was activated. The implications were clear.

「Apollon and the Constellations have obtained the tale of the second round's 'Returnee War'.」

['Staging' is truly activating.]

[It seems that the 'Demon of the Horizon' gave the real thing.]

The Demon of the Horizon.

They had succeeded in obtaining the tale of another worldline through a deal with a sponsor.

[Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.]

But I wasn't panicked.

[This 'Staging' isn't perfect.]

'Staging' doesn't normally activate with tales alone.

The key conditions for a proper 'Staging' are the 'main characters' and 'tales' that will recreate the relevant history. The likelihood of the story being staged is further enhanced when historical locations or 'mediation' are included. But the Constellations had activated 'Staging' with just a single story. That meant they had forcibly recreated the stage, leveraging the probability of the Giant Nebula.

[A stage activated in that manner cannot function properly. I will help. If we fight together—]

Tsutsutsu, sparks flew through the air at that moment. The surrounding scenery grew even darker. The approaching Constellations—especially Apollo—saw the powerful narrating power pulsating through their entire bodies.

['Staging' intensifies!]

That couldn't be.

Even with a Giant Nebula, there was no way they could recreate such a forced stage.

As if reading my thoughts, Apollo spoke.

[Did you think it was an 'incomplete stage'?]

Two heads dangling from the creature's waistband were visible. One was unfamiliar, but the other belonged to someone I knew well.

「Blood Demon, Yeom Baekho.」

The head of the Blood Demon, who had driven Breaking the Sky Sword Saint to her death in the second round's battle, hung on Apollo's waist, staring at me. Goosebumps slowly crept up my spine as I watched the bloody tears streaming from its eyes.

「Only then did Kim Dokja understand the design of this stage.」

To recreate this stage, the Constellations had traveled to other 'Murim' regions, harvesting the heads of the Blood Demon and Heavenly Demon.

Furthermore, perhaps using a special method, the Blood Demon survived, writhing with only his head remaining.

[It's time to complete the stage, you poor mortal.]

Apollo rammed the Blood Demon's head into the center of the artificial sun floating behind him.

Aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa—!

The Blood Demon's head opened its eyes and let out a terrifying scream. A torrent of stories flowed ceaselessly from its gaping mouth.

[The story, 'Master of the Blood Cult', begins its storytelling!]

Transplanting a living Blood Demon into an artificial sun to recreate it as a 'character' required for this stage.

「This was Apollo and the Constellations' plan.」

Even Vidar had inserted the head of the Heavenly Demon into the maw of his sacred relic, the 'Wolf Skin'.

Incidentally, Vidar's wolf skin possessed the power to borrow the stories of the 'incarnations' it devoured.

[The effect of the item, 'Wolf Skin of the End', is activated!]

[The reproducibility of 'Staging' is enhanced!]

I never would have thought those lazy Constellations would prepare so thoroughly just to take down a single Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

[Strike.]

At Apollo's command, the Constellations charged towards Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

[The story, 'Returnee War', continues its storytelling.]

The flurries of spears and swords flying from all directions were ominous. Like martial artists using formations, the Constellations, gathered together, were blocking the sword of the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

[You otherworldly monster! You're finally weakened!]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's body was covered in wounds. Her arms, legs, back. As the sudden explosion of stories drifted through the air, Apollo's artificial sun shone

brightly.

[Get out of the way.]

The Blood Demon embedded in the artificial sun opened its mouth, and a flash of light erupted, striking Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's left arm.

「Anti-flame flash.」

Apollo's stigma, unquenchable until its target was reduced to ashes.

As the blazing flames spread, burning her left arm to a pitch-black ember, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint cut it off without a moment's hesitation. Her left arm fell to the ground, crumbling like rotten wood. The Constellations, seizing the moment, thrust their swords once more.

[Now! Kill!]

Watching Apollo's artificial sun reload its flash once more, I stood beside Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

[I will help.]

The enemy numbered in the hundreds of Constellations. Even if I joined the battle now, it might not have much of an impact on the battlefield. However.

[I will try to prevent this 'Staging'.]

In the '40th round', I fought the Blood Demon as 'Cheon Inho', and I even inflicted a spirit of magic possession on the Blood Demon with [Incite].

As I vividly recalled that memory, I felt the slumbering story within me awaken.

[The effect of the trait, 'Record Repairer', activates!]

「"There's no place for you in the <Star Stream>. You're nothing more than a speck of dust, not even a supporting role. Accept that fact, and you'll feel better. Go back to where you used to live. And never show your face again."」

[The story, 'Gaslighting Expert', temporarily awakens!]

One of my traits manifested, and the story of the 40th round began to inhabit my entire being.

Of course, this history wasn't related to the 'Blood Demon' of the 41st round.

Nevertheless, some history can transcend worldlines and manifest its influence.

Indeed, the Blood Demon's reaction to my story was peculiar.

"What, whatwhatwhatwhatwhatwhatwhat—"

[The 'Staging' begins to shake!]

The Blood Demon's expression, pierced by the artificial sun, distorted like a vicious slaughter, and he began to tremble.

Halla tilted her head at the Blood Demon's strange reaction and asked.

[What is it? Apollo. What's going on?]

Apollo was equally strange. His face paled, as if he'd eaten something rotten, and he glared at me.

[That guy unleashed a strange story on the stage.]

He seemed to have realized I was the culprit disrupting the 'Staging'.

[Kick out the uninvited guests.]

I said, swatting away the weapons rushing toward me.

[The uninvited guests are not me, but you.]

I leaped onto the stage of the 'Returnee War.

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', watches your exploits!]

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', awaits your transformation!]

The Constellations charging toward Breaking the Sky Sword Saint turned to me. I sneered faintly at the sight of the Five Hundred Generals, each wearing the rags of dead martial artists, trying to enhance the stage performance even a little.

[What do you hope to become by taking over the stage of the incarnations like this?]

[Shut up!]

A blind arrow grazed my side. All the Constellations gathered here were at least Narrative-grade. It was clearly a critical situation. The power of the stage incarnation was powerful, and the number of enemies was simply too great.

「I smiled at them.」

The 'Kim Dokja' within me was awakening.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', rejoices in you.]

The history of resisting Fate and fighting against the Constellations commanded me on my behalf.

「Use the power of the King of Fear.」

The moment the fearful story, imperfectly floating within me, was about to reveal its true form once again.

[Not yet.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's large hand gripped my shoulder. The shadow of a giant loomed overhead. She, who had activated [Immortal Immortality] and [Protective Strength] to withstand the Constellations' attacks, stood in my way.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', glares at 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung'.]

The sparks that flew wildly burned Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's right hand, turning it pitch-black.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint silently endured the pain and spoke.

[This is not a space granted to you.]

Vines sprouted from the ground, entangling my limbs. Before I could even call Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's name, the Constellations stirred. It was a breathtaking sight, as if all the Constellations in the world were pouring down on her. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint silently readjusted her grip on her sword.

「Breaking the Sky Yuseonggyeol.」

The secret energy of [Breaking the Sky Sword Saint] erupted once more.

Kwakwakwakwakwakwakwa.

Stories blossomed from her entire body.

A boundlessly magnificent and beautiful story blossom.

The sword's shattering shattered into thousands of fragments, piercing through the Constellations. The 'Returnee War' wasn't necessarily a battlefield unfavorable to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

「This is the power of a mortal who has reached the pinnacle of transcendence.」

During the Noble War, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint single-handedly annihilated 90% of the Blood Cult and Demonic Cult and successfully repelled most of the disasters.

「Amidst the cries of disaster filled with vengeful spirits, the indifferent Breaking the Sky Sword dominated the battlefield.」

The Constellations that supported the Blood Demon and Heavenly Demon suffered significant losses due to Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's actions. Later, the 'Returnee War' became an opportunity for the constellations to become wary of the existence of the 'Transcendental Alliance'.

[Kuaaaaaaah! Why! The 'Stage Effect' was clearly activated, but why—]

The narrative unfolded on the stage. The more Breaking the Sky Sword Saint exerted her power, the more the Constellations were helplessly swept away. Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk had seen Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's back countless times.

「There was a master of the Regressor, feared even by the Constellations.」

It’s truly a martial arts that had reached the realm of god. Perhaps a single individual's power could shatter the 'Stage'—a fleeting hope.

If it weren't for a single sword that had pierced, waiting for an opening, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint would surely have succeeded in destroying the Constellations’ stage.

「And then a single sword pierced the god's waist.」

Halla's mantra was heard.

[You are truly an incredible incarnation.]

With a thud, a pitch-black blade pierced breaking the Sky Sword Saint's abdomen.

I knew that sword.

「Heavenly Demon Divine Sword.」

The divine relic of the Demon Sect that had fatally wounded Breaking the Sky Sword Saint in the second round.

[The influence of 'Staging' is strengthened!]

Halla, holding the Heavenly Demon Divine Sword, spoke with admiration.

[I acknowledge you, great mortal.]

As Halla's story began to infuse her swordplay, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's body began to freeze. Constellations' attacks rained down on her frozen body.

「Thus, the end of the 'Returnee War' was drawing near.」

Seeing Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's body crumbling, I cried out in a fit of rage.

[Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Release me!]

But the vines, as if responding to my command, tightened their grip on me.

At that moment, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's body unleashed another explosive blast. Halla's incarnation body was flung away with a roar of shock, and Breaking the Sky Sword Saint called out to me.

[Sad Recorder of the Stars.]

I gazed into her eyes.

A gleam of light.

Her eyes, facing my ■■, burned like bright stars.

No, perhaps it was her.

Perhaps it was the starlight in the sky she had gazed upon all her life. To shatter the sky contained in those eyes, she had swung her sword for all those ages.

[Do you still think you can fight the world?]

Her [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] moved. With each trajectory, the starlight in the sky flickered. The sky was so lush with stars that a single sword could cut through it.

[You can fight, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. Unleash this now. It's not too late. You can change history.]

I felt the passage of time slowly slowing. It was proof that this 'stage' was drawing near its conclusion.

Nevertheless, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's expression remained composed. As if sitting on the veranda sipping a cup of tea, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint spoke to me in a calm and serene voice.

[It was the first time my disciple brought a friend to Murim.]

Memories flowed through her clear vision.

「"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."」

When I first visited Murim with Yoo Joonghyuk, now a child, to enter Fear Realm—I told her that.

「"Isn't there really a single tree left in this Murim that you seek to protect?"」

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint continued, as if answering that age-old question.

[My disciple is a mistrustful person. His distrust was so great that he would often vomit even food prepared by his master.]

Explosive stories began to rise from her body. The story blossoms took the form of pitch-black trees, instantly covering the ground, soon blocking out even the starlight and forming a forest.

[When we first met, you asked me how many trees it takes to make a forest.]

In the pitch-black forest, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's eyes shone with a dazzling starlight.

[I've protected this Murim for a long time, but I still don't know the answer.]

Only when I met her eyes did I fully realize what Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had been protecting all this time.

「She wasn't protecting 'Murim'.」

Since Yoo Joonghyuk's return began, what she had protected was simply a landscape for one person.

A place where the returning man, exhausted from his long journey, would temporarily block the starlight for him when he turned around.

The Constellations roared, trying to destroy the forest. The forest leaves rustled violently, erupting in a deafening roar.

[However, no matter how many trees there were—]

As night faded and dawn broke, starlight began to slowly filter through the forest she had created. In that poignant yet beautiful landscape, I finally understood Yoo Joonghyuk.

[I wish the place where my disciple stood could be called a forest.]

The reason he never gave up on the scenarios, despite being betrayed, hurt, and despairing so much.

「Yoo Joonghyuk has long resembled his teacher.」

Even if only one tree remained in the forest, he would not give up on it.

[So, please take good care of the forest, young Recorder.]

A giant tree was falling before my eyes.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 947 Episode 55 Giant Tree (13)

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I tore at Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's vines with all my might. My right arm, barely extended, touched her back.

[Breaking the Sky Sword Saint! Stop!]

I couldn't understand. The Breaking the Sky Sword Saint I knew would never do something like this. She was the teacher of the Regressor. She was a fierce competitor who never gave up on a fight if there was even the slightest chance of victory.

「"This is the first time my disciple has brought a friend to Murim."」

My heart pounded with unease. Starlight bloomed throughout the crumbling forest.

[Pass on the 'story' to my disciple.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's hand shoved me. With just a light shove, I plummeted, as if being sucked into the ground. A suction force, unavoidable even with [Way of the Wind], was pulling me downward.

[Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!]

At the last moment, I unleashed my power as the Recorder. The sentences I held tangled at my fingertips.

[Exclusive skill, '□□', activates!]

It was an uncertain gamble. Nevertheless, if this story was the 'Returnee War, there was one 'record' I could gamble on.

In an instant, the [Fate] I had written was sucked toward Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, and in an instant, the starry landscape faded away.

In the encroaching darkness, the story of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint faded. A painful sensation surged through me, twitching at the base of my heart.

「Why me again?」

My breathing became labored, and I found it difficult to breathe.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', repeats its painful story.]

A destructive impulse consumed my mind, and my thoughts drifted away and then closer. In my endless descent, all kinds of stories flowed into my ears. They were all stories of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

「"She's a woman of filthy blood. Don't associate with her."」

The childhood of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, born of mixed blood with the Giants.

「"You cannot inherit Namgung's martial arts."」

The sorrow of being abandoned by the Namgung family.

「"I worked harder than you. I trained harder than you!"」

The cries of fellow martial artists frustrated by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's talent.

「"If you were born half-human, half-god, you might be able to challenge the throne of the heavens."」

The voice of Yoo Hoseong, the master she met in the 'Time Fault'.

「"Interesting. Do you wish to ascend to the throne of the stars in a mortal body?"」

The despair she felt for the first time upon facing a Mythical Constellation. And—

「"Teach me the sword."」

Her disciple.

[You have approached the source of the 'Impossible Justice'.]

When I opened my eyes in the darkness with that message, my feet were on soft dirt. I took a deep breath and blinked, slowly adapting to the dark. The scent of water reached my nose. I knew it without anyone having to tell me.

「This is a 'forest'.」

It was puzzling. Why was there such a 'forest' inside the World Tree?

I slowly looked around and saw creatures raising their heads from the deep jungle. No, strictly speaking, they weren't 'living things'.

Beings that were a mixture of different stories.

I knew the names they called them.

[Nameless Things.]

One by one, they gathered, surrounding me.

Some even extended their long antennae, as if searching for prey, carefully scanning my stories.

【What】

And then one of them spoke.

【Whatwhatwhatwh

【Let'seatlet'seatlet'seatlet'seatlet'seatlet'seatlet'seatlet'seatlet'seat】

I wonder if I smell delicious. Whether it's an Outer God or a Constellation, when they see me, they'll put their snout first.

When the 'Nameless Things' opened their mouths all at once, their sharp fangs shone white in the dark.

I don't know why there are these things inside Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. I didn't mean to hurt them, but if they showed their hostility first, there was no way for me.

I warned the guys lightly.

[Go back, otherwise—]

In an instant, the swarm of 'Nameless Things' shuddered violently and opened a path. At first, I thought they were reacting to my words, but upon closer inspection, I saw something approaching from afar.

The sound of waves echoed from somewhere. Salty air brushed my nose, and goosebumps slowly rose from my toes.

[You.]

An Outer God with a long, streamlined body. A fin resembling a shark's.

The 'Fear' I knew so well was there.

[You're alive!]

With the crash of waves, the creature thrust its massive fin toward me.

【TeethTeethTeethT

One of the few Outer Gods I tamed in the 'Fear Realm'.

I thought it died when the 'Fear Realm' was destroyed, but surprisingly, it was still alive.

Judging by its fluttering movements, it seemed to be still healthy, but a closer look revealed a few missing teeth. As I gazed at the gaps in its teeth, a thought suddenly occurred to me.

「The corporations were collecting the 'Fears' that survived the 'Fear Realm'.」

What if the 'Fears' captured by the corporations were trapped underground in <Tamra Heavy Industries> along with Breaking the Sky Sword Saint? And what if the 'World Tree' blossomed and brought all those Fears into this forest?

【Whoohoohoohoohoohoo—】

A long howl echoed from somewhere, and the entire forest shook violently. A headless dragon roared through the sky, and the gigantic Fears scattered throughout the area rose one by one.

「"All those dreams cannot become a single Oldest Dream. Therefore, there must be a place where abandoned dreams gather."」

A record echoed in my head. It was a phrase I knew very well. I had read it myself in the 'Fear Realm'.

「Apocalyptic Fear, a Prophecy of the End.」

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint told me,

Please take care of the 'forest'.

「"Beyond time and space, there will be a very big house that is not bound by the laws of the Dokkaebis."」

A very big house.

【Teethteethteethteethteethteethteeth!]】

With the roar of 'Tooth Fin', powerful Fears began to gather.

「The 'Fear Realm' wasn't destroyed.」

The Outer Gods, whose mere presence threatened me, were approaching, their bodies large and small, tossing and turning.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had preserved the 'Fear Realm' within her forest.」

[The 'Fourth Wall' responds!]

At the same time, something stirred within me. With the help of the 'Demon King of Salvation', the Fears dormant within the [Fourth Wall] were awakening.

【Ooooooooooooooo—】

The Fears, raising their heads to the void, let out a mournful cry. As if remembering that cry, a mixture of joy and sorrow, the record continued.

「"There, all dreams are free as Fear. In the incomprehensible snowfield of dreams, the King of Fear will smile, neither light nor darkness."」

I had always thought the prophecy of the end was over. But perhaps I was mistaken. The story of the Fear Realm was not over, and the Fears that needed to be recorded still swarmed upon this margin.

[The old Fears sense your presence.]

Only then did I realize why Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had prevented me from using my power.

[The Fears of 'Murim' listen to your story.]

I felt the gazes of Fears glaring at me from the pitch-black darkness. Not all of them were kind to me. I sensed hostility from some, anger from others.

I took a deep breath and looked up at the Fears staring down at me. The 'Tooth Fin' guarding me growled, while the Fears of the abyss dripped black saliva at me. I grinned at them.

[Yes, you're all very hungry.]

With a roar, the Fears charged.

[The story, 'King of Fear', begins its storytelling.]

I realized that this was the final test of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. If I survived this...

「"When that day comes, the boundary of Fear will open, and the King of Fear will descend."」

In this <Star Stream>, the 'Fear Realm' will open once again, and the end that the Constellations feared will begin.

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Breaking the Sky Sword Saint briefly gazed into the darkness of the forest where Kim Dokja had fallen, then closed the passage. As soon as the flow of time returned to normal, the Constellations' weapons and energies were pierced into her arms and legs.

The Constellations cheered as they watched her stagger.

[Enough! She's almost down!]

Even as the excruciating pain surged through her, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint thought of the Recorder, who had reached out to her in her final moments.

[Someone is sharing your 'story'.]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', assists with the recording.]

Record. Perhaps this was the last gift the young Recorder left her. The child, too, had sensed it. That her story in this worldline ended here.

With a thud, the Heavenly Demon Sword pierced her chest.

[Still holding on? You possess remarkable vitality.]

As if to counter the murmurs of the Constellations, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint swung her sword once more.

[The story, 'Returnee War', is nearing its end.]

Raising her head, she saw a familiar sight. The corpses of martial artists strewn everywhere. Constellations bearing the stories of the Heavenly Demon and the Blood Demon were approaching her.

As if observing her end, the Constellations that adorned the sky radiated pure white light and gazed upon her.

[Constellations, though my story ends here.]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint smiled impassively at the Constellations.

[One day, my disciple will come to you.]

She couldn't understand why she would say such a thing. She had no right to say such things.

Strictly speaking, she was Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's 'thought', and therefore, she wasn't even Breaking the Sky Sword Saint. More than anything, she hoped her disciple wouldn't fight for her. She hoped he wouldn't challenge those cruel Constellations.

She wanted him to end his long tragedy and simply find happiness.

[Disciple?]

The Constellations burst into laughter. It was Hanra who stepped forward, stopping them.

[I will remember you. Close your eyes, great mortal.]

With Hanra's mantra, the Heavenly Demon Sword pierced the air and flew.

The Breaking the Sky Divine Sword broke, and time slowed once again.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint realized this was the end.

「There was a scene she wanted to see one last time.」

In her final moments, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint recalled a memory from the moment she first mastered [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship].

「"Master, can a human really cut 'heavens'?"」

To her question, the invincible Yoo Hoseong answered.

「"Even if we can’t do it, the next generation, or the generation after that, will be able to."」

In his characteristically slow voice, Yoo Hoseong looked up at the sky and spoke.

「"If no one gives up, the day will surely come when we accumulate mortality and reach eternity."」

Even if we swing our swords with all our might, even if we pour our lives into every single day, the Constellations remain as distant as eternity.

[The story, 'Returnee War', continues its storytelling.]

Remembering her teacher's empty voice, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint gripped her sword.

「"Then I won't be able to see that scenery."」

As if squeezing out her last words, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint swung her sword once more. The halved sword emitted a final, bright light.

「"I want to see that scenery with my own eyes."」

But her exhausted story was unable to block the Heavenly Demon Sword's sword strike and was scattered. Halla's sword strike flew towards Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's heart.

[The 'Fate' someone had bestowed upon you is coming true!]

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint accepted her fate. Never once in her life had she taken her eyes off the sky, so she kept them closed until the very end.

「Breaking the Sky Sword Saint didn't miss that scenery this time either.」

A strange sound was heard from across the sky.

A sound as if the boundary of the universe was shattering. In a moment when the noisy Constellations fell silent, a single trajectory appeared in the vast sky.

「It was just a single sword strike.」

A trajectory shattered time and space, tearing through the sky. As countless Constellations burst apart, unable to even scream, Apollo let out a terrified cry.

[What, what on earth is happening—?]

No Constellation could answer that question. However, for the first time, the Constellations looked up to a sky higher than their own.

「The sword of destruction she had long dreamed of was there.」

Once again, the trajectory tore through the sky.

Amidst the falling Constellations stood a man. A being who had alone carried on the long-held desires of mortals for generations.

「Finally, a man who had become a giant tree that could even despise the heavens was there.」

A being who had learned her martial arts, her faith, her fighting spirit, and reached the other side of transcendence. The martial artists who had long admired her called her by this name, expressing their respect for her.

"Get away from my master."

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's disciple, the Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 948 Episode 55 Giant Tree (14)

A phrase suddenly flashed through his mind.

「...Breaking the Sky Sword Saint...」

When he first heard that story, Yoo Joonghyuk thought he had finally gone mad after years of training.

To him now, it wasn't particularly unusual.

He had already experienced 41 regressions, repeatedly losing his memory as he repeated his life. He had been captured and tortured by Constellations, and even entered the belly of a deity from another world.

And that wasn't all. He was now being tortured by a stabbing monster from another world, so it wouldn't be surprising if he suddenly lost his mind and became delusional.

"Concentrate. Your mind is wandering."

Yoo Joonghyuk steeled himself once more. Just as he had said, a new realm was now before him. The realm he had longed for, the realm where he could mercilessly tear apart those Constellations.

「...It's dangerous... but...」

「If only I could see it one last time.」

But with each successive sentence, his concentration continued to drift.

"Thoughts keep coming to me."

Jaehwan frowned, dumbfounded by Yoo Joonghyuk's words.

"Thoughts? Are you trying to joke?"

"I'm not kidding."

It had been hundreds of years of training. Training utilizing the time density of a highly compressed Time Fault. The end of that training was just around the corner. And yet, amidst all this, you're talking about distracting thoughts?

"You pathetic bastard."

Jaehwan, staring blankly into the empty air, suddenly reached out and grabbed the sentence floating through space and time.

「...If I miss this opportunity...」

Stories writhed painfully in Jaehwan's strong grip.

"This guy is the culprit. I'll get rid of it."

Faced by Jaehwan's impatience, Yoo Joonghyuk hurriedly stepped in to stop him.

"Wait. Such a story can't suddenly appear. We need to find out where it came from."

Jaehwan's lips twitched in annoyance, but his eyes quickly glowed golden. His [Suspicion] was discerning the origin of the story.

"It came through an item you possessed."

"Item?"

"Midday Tryst. Is there such an item?"

Startled, Yoo Joonghyuk immediately checked the item. Then, the item activation message actually appeared before his eyes.

['Midday Tryst' is currently active.]

He wondered where the story had come from, but it seemed to have seeped into this channel.

"Is that him?"

Frowning, Yoo Joonghyuk considered it for a moment before calling out to someone.

"■■■."

The message was immediately filtered.

Yoo Joonghyuk tried to correct the name.

"Kim Dokja."

The story, as if responding to the name, grew even stronger.

「…Breaking the Sky Sword Saint looked up at the sky one last time.」

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyebrows twitched. It was a story about his master, a story he knew well.

A story he'd wanted to change countless times—but never could.

A story that taught him despair and vengeance, a story that shaped him into who he was.

The fact that he was hearing this sentence now, of all times…

"Someone seems to be looking for you."

Yoo Joonghyuk's mind was deeply disturbed. He was on the verge of the final stage of his training, and he couldn't just leave.

Nevertheless, the words written in the story were earnest.

Jaehwan looked down at Yoo Joonghyuk for a moment, then turned to the direction the story had come from. The power of [Suspension] radiating from his eyes was staring down the path it had flowed from.

"I can send you away for a moment with my power."

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been silent, raised his head. Perhaps reading the emotion in his eyes, Jaehwan spoke again.

"But if you leave now, you'll never reach beyond the meadow. But if you dare, I'll let you go."

Beyond the meadow, Yoo Joonghyuk now knew for sure that such a realm existed. The man before him was precisely that realm.

Beyond the limits, a monster capable of confronting even those fearsome Mythical Constellations, Jaehwan was such a being.

"I."

Yoo Joonghyuk knew this was a fate that would never happen again. If he left here, his contract with Jaehwan would end.

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk thought. If this story meant the situation he was thinking of —

"It seems you're already made up your mind."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

Looking at Yoo Joonghyuk, Jaehwan muttered softly, perhaps thinking about something.

"Sometimes, it's important not to forget your purpose of becoming stronger."

As Jaehwan spoke, his pupils clouded for a moment. Perhaps he was reminiscing about something old.

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't know what Jaehwan had lost to become this strong. However, the strength of a being is largely determined by the magnitude of the loss it has endured. Considering the fact that it was proportional, he cautiously guessed that Jaehwan must also be harboring an immense amount of sadness.

Jaehwan asked again.

"Are you going now?"

"Can you send me off?"

Jaehwan nodded.

"But there's a condition."

"Condition?"

"You won't use the 'spear' in this fight. "Because you're not ready to use it yet."

Yoo Joonghyuk pondered for a moment, then nodded.

"And what else?"

"I can't send your incarnation body there myself."

"What do you mean?"

"If I use my power to throw you there, your body won't be able to withstand the impact."

"Then how are you going to send me there?"

Jaehwan's lips twisted into an inexplicable smile.

"It's not necessary for the 'incarnation body' to go there yourself."

Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly stood up, overcome by a sudden sense of foreboding.

"Wait, you—"

"Go."

Jaehwan's palm touched Yoo Joonghyuk's back. And in the next moment, Yoo Joonghyuk felt as if his soul was being shaken.

"Go, prove to this world that you've endured here."

Yoo Joonghyuk's soul, ejected from his body, traversed the <Star Stream> like a meteor. Across the vast starlight, Yoo Joonghyuk headed to the world of the scenarios.

Under normal circumstances, entering the scenarios with a pure soul would have been impossible.

But this time, the circumstances were special.

「This place is a kind of Fear.」

[Natural Disaster-level Fear, 'Impossible Justice' reacts to 'Yoo Joonghyuk's' justice.]

Under the protection of [Fate] written by someone, the power of 'Fear', which grants strength to the strong justice, manifested.

「That justice was born solely to avenge his master.」

With a dazzling beam of light, Yoo Joonghyuk felt skin forming over his soul. His incarnation body, overlaid with someone's memories, was regenerating on the battlefield of the past.

「Yoo Joonghyuk knew this battlefield.」

The battlefield that had taken his master. A Returnee War caused by the calamities that had returned to the 'First Murim' out of hatred for the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

「Back then, Yoo Joonghyuk was weak. That's why he couldn't protect his master.」

[What the hell is that guy!]

The Constellations in the sky roared at Yoo Joonghyuk's appearance.

A probability aftershock raged.

His coat fluttered among the falling Constellations.

[Kwaaaaak!]

Yoo Joonghyuk descended to the center of the battlefield, his sword piercing with a rippling, pulsating energy.

A temporary body gained through the effects of 'Fear'.

The air of the scenarios filled his lungs for the first time in a while.

Yoo Joonghyuk quickly absorbed the information from the battlefield.

「Stage.」

「The fallen Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.」

「Constellations.」

[Sage's Eye emitted a dazzling light and began to read the situation.]

[What! What are you doing!]

[Where do you dare say we are! An incarnation in this sacred battlefield...]

The sword moved, and the heads of the Constellations fell like toys.

Yoo Joonghyuk's sword was neither the 'Jincheon Sword' nor the 'Heukcheon Demon Sword'. It was simply a broken sword floating in the skies of the battlefield.

That single broken sword. Holding it, Yoo Joonghyuk ran relentlessly across the battlefield.

「It was a familiar scenario to him.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, covered in pitch-black yet divine energy, seemed to descend upon a mountain of scholarly writings. Dozens of Constellations were slaughtered in an instant, and eventually, the higher-ranking Constellations stepped forward.

[Is that guy the so-called 'disciple'?]

Vidar uttered an unpleasant mantra and released his energy. His wolf skin emitted a mysterious light and began to pour out stories.

[The story, 'Conqueror of the Sect', begins its storytelling!]

[The story, 'Conqueror of the Hundred Thousand Great Mountains', begins its storytelling.]

The story of the Heavenly Demon, the leader of the Demon Sect.

The essence of that story was being recreated through Vidar's incarnation body.

「The Master of the Hundred Thousand Great Mountains endured a thousand years solely for revenge.」

The story of the Heavenly Demon, who returned as a disaster, single-mindedly seeking revenge against Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

Yoo Joonghyuk immediately recognized the story.

"The power of the Heavenly Demon. Were you using this as a stage transformation?"

The Heavenly Demon was the key protagonist of the 'Returnee War'.

As the story of the Heavenly Demon blossomed in earnest, wounds large and small began to appear on Yoo Joonghyuk's new body.

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', observes the situation with a complicated gaze.]

Vidar, smiling with satisfaction, poured his power into the Heavenly Demon's fist.

[There's a certain pleasure in the struggle between mortals.]

As if this were the end, Vidar's fist struck Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The story, 'Returnee War', continues its storytelling.]

As if he had hit a solid wall, Yoo Joonghyuk's left hand caught his fist.

[What—]

A look of bewilderment crossed Vidar's expression. It was a blow that no ordinary incarnation could have withstood. Even without the effects of 'stage transformation', he was already a Constellation approaching mythical status. How could a mere incarnation have withstood his blow—

"I."

Starlight blazed in the eyes of the disciple, who resembled his master.

"How many times do you think I've killed the Heavenly Demon?"

Vidar's eyes widened, realizing belatedly that something was wrong.

「For Yoo Joonghyuk, the 'Returnee War' wasn't a 'one-time event'.」

[The story, 'Returnee War' reacts to the memories of incarnation 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.]

The sword light surged before his eyes.

This instant, Vidar couldn't come to his senses.

[Kwaaaaaaaah!]

With a helpless scream, Vidar's entire body was reduced to tatters.

「It was a mistake for Vidar to borrow the story of the Heavenly Demon.」

Yoo Joonghyuk had already prevented the 'Returnee War' and killed the Heavenly Demon several times. That age-old story was already influencing the 'stage'.

[The very foundation of the 'stage' is beginning to shake!]

Vidar, who had just finished drawing a handful of story, hurriedly prepared to deviate from the scenario. But Yoo Joonghyuk's sword was a little faster. The moment the halved blade finally sliced through Vidar's neck,

[This is not your stage.]

With a harsh crack, Halla's Heavenly Demon Sword struck Yoo Joonghyuk's sword.

Halla's eyes were deep.

She stared at Yoo Joonghyuk with a stern gaze and added,

[You, a young mortal, have achieved something remarkable. I sense the dignity of a nobleman in you. I have no desire to harm your descendants—]

Halla, who had been speaking up to that point, fell silent. More precisely, she could no longer continue.

"Is there anything left to say?"

Yoo Joonghyuk's sword, moving in a strange trajectory, sliced through Halla's lower body. Apollo stepped in to take Halla's place, who was paralyzed by shock.

[Kill him first!]

With Apollo's shout, the Five Hundred Generals charged at Yoo Joonghyuk simultaneously. Yoo Joonghyuk dodged their fire and stood beside Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"Master."

The Master he had finally encountered after a long time was not the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint he remembered. Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, already half-transparent, opened her lips as if trying to convey something to him. It seemed like a call to run, and another to survive.

Yoo Joonghyuk lifted Breaking the Sky Sword Saint onto his back and laid her down under a nearby tree.

It was a shade where starlight couldn't reach.

"Stay here."

The shadows of the leaves swayed darkly over Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's face. Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at his master for a moment, then gazed into the vast sky.

The Constellations, blazing with radiance, raced toward him. The sky overflowed with Constellations possessing immense power, unmatched by anyone in the Star Stream.

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk remained calm. It wasn't simply because he had grown stronger through his training.

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, watching her disciple's back, moved her lips with difficulty.

[Joonghyuk-ah.]

It was the disciple's back she had seen countless times. The Regressor, running forward with his eyes fixed on the ground. The disciple turned around.

Only at that moment did Breaking the Sky Sword Saint realize something.

「Perhaps the last sight she longed to see wasn't the trajectory of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship].」

The disciple's eyes were filled with starlight. A star, invisible to her vision, flickered within his.

「Even if this forest were made of a single tree.」

Breaking the Sky Sword Saint gazed at the sky, as if gazing into her disciple's eyes. Then, her disciple looked up at the same sky.

[What a distant star.]

Perhaps it was because the starlight was so thick, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's eyes couldn't see the star her disciple was looking at.

In the fading light, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint asked,

[Can you do it?]

Yoo Joonghyuk swung his sword in silence. Cracks spread across the sky, and stars began to fall.

Looking at the shattered night sky, Breaking the Sky Sword Saint pictured a tree stretching its branches toward the stars.

A tree that bears no fruit or leaves. A tree that grows solely to destroy this world.

[The story, 'Returnee War', concludes its storytelling.]

In the shade cast by the tree, the God of Murim finally fell into a deep sleep.

---

A series of violent tremors echoed around the World Tree.

The Constellation of Tamra—the 'Ruler of the South Sea Dragon Palace'—who had been observing the World Tree's movements from the skies of the 'New Murim' spoke in an anxious voice.

[What's the situation internally?]

One of the Five Hundred Generals prostrated himself in shame and said,

[Contact with General Halla has been lost.]

[What about Apollo? What happened to Vidar?]

[We can't contact them either.]

That couldn't be possible. As far as he knew, Halla, Apollo, and Vidar had acquired fragments of the 'Oldest Dream' and were near-Mythical Constellations.

But what could be happening inside that could cause all three to lose contact simultaneously? There were only two possibilities to consider.

One, that the 'World Tree' was a 'Fear' far more powerful than they had imagined.

Second, that within that 'World Tree' lay a being more powerful than even the Constellations approaching Mthical level.

In either case, it was not a pleasant situation for them.

The Ruler of the South Sea Dragon Palace, relying solely on Halla's words, had brought Tamra's main force here without the consent of the Mythical Constellation 'Seolmundae Halmang'.

If the Mythical Constellations were to catch wind of this—

[Dragon King, we've received a call from Olympus.]

[Tell them I'm busy. I don't have time to receive such a call right now—]

A dizzying thunder rumbled from afar.

The Five Hundred Generals, their faces paling, added,

[The 'Thunderbolt' has contacted us directly.]

Zeus's name sent a violent shiver through the Dragon King's eyes.

[Buy time, somehow. They mustn't find out.]

[Dragon King. Even <Asgard>…]

[<Hogeun> has contacted us!]

It was the worst possible situation.

<Tamra> had already deployed the 'Five Hundred Generals', including Halla, risking a critical power vacuum in a higher-level scenario. If any sabotage from other Myth-level Constellations were to occur, <Tamra> would face annihilation.

[It's futile. The 'Myth's' seat is right before our eyes—]

Looking around, the other Myth-level Constellations seemed to be thinking similarly.

[We must halt this plan, South Sea Dragon King.]

[Not only the Lightning Constellation, but the other Myth-level Constellations must have realized the situation. Right now, we can cut off Apollo line's tail.]

[If by any chance the Myth-level beings discover this plan… ]

The 'World Tree Cultivation Plan' of the 'New Murim District' was a scenario carried out without the consent of the Myth-level Constellations.

If the Myth-level Constellations were held accountable for this incident, not only Tamra, but all the Myth-level Constellations involved in this story would bear the responsibility.

The Constellations that entered the World Tree had lost contact, the World Tree was out of control, and the arrival of a Myth-level Constellation was uncertain.

[All Constellations of the 'New Murim District', including the Five Hundred Generals, listen up.]

After a brief moment of deliberation, the South Sea Dragon King finally made a decision.

[I will seal the 'World Tree' from now on.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 949 Episode 56 Myth (1)

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「I believe that day, <Murim> was reborn.」

—The last survivor of the Namgung family, Namgung Myung

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When Apollo opened his eyes, the first thing he saw was the vast sky.

A vast universe with no end in sight. An eternal void where any story could be written, yet where even a story written could never be complete.

The Constellation, staring into that terrible void, howled in Fear and began to fill its surroundings with its own stories.

「The great throne of lightning has discovered the floating island of emptiness.」

Later, he heard that he was born on a forgotten island floating on a 'Time Fault'.

「The god, with his own lightning strike, erected four pillars to secure the island.」

A radiant lightning strike lifted the island, hidden within the Time Fault, above the surface of the scenario. Because of this history, the island was named 'Delos'.

「A woman who could not give birth anywhere on earth finally gave birth to a Constellation on an island...」

There, the woman gave birth to the child of the 'Thunderbolt'. A brilliant ray of light filled the entire Time Fault. His name was chosen based on that ray.

「That Constellation is called 'Apollo'.」

A Constellation born on the Isle of the Void.

The legend of his birth protected him in the lonely world of scenarios.

The son of a Mythical Constellation. Chosen as a Constellation from birth—a being destined to become one of the Twelve Gods of the lofty <Olympus> from the moment of his birth.

He was none other than Apollo, the 'Almighty Sun'.

[The story, 'Child of the Forgotten Castle', cares for you.]

He opened his eyes, his soul fixed on his incarnation body, and heard a story from a distant and ancient time.

As Apollo pondered the story, someone spoke to him.

[Have you opened your eyes, my brother?]

The story of Apollo, one of his brothers born before him, revealed who he was.

[Master of the Skywalk.]

When Apollo recognized him, Hermes stroked him lovingly and whispered.

[Congratulations, brother, on being born as the '14th Apollo'.]

---

When he opened his eyes again, Apollo realized his incarnation body had been destroyed.

The last memory that came to mind was the sword light engulfing him. And the dazzling gleam of the incarnation's eyes.

'Did I get hit by that thing?'

Apollo bit his lip, concentrating on his story.

[The story, 'Child of the Forgotten Castle', raises you.]

His origin story was restoring his incarnation body. He briefly regained consciousness, but the story remained intact. It was only natural. He was one of the Twelve Gods of the Nebula Olympus.

[The story, 'Epic of Light' continues.]

Even if he dies here, his story will not disappear.

「The Twelve Gods of Olympus are immortal.」

All his stories are stored in Olympus's 'big data', so as long as Olympus remains intact—and as long as its leader, the 'Seat of Lightning', remains intact—he can be resurrected.

「He is the 'fourteenth' Apollo.」

There were already thirteen Apollos born before him.

All the Apollos, each dedicated to the greater glory of the Nebula Olympus and their father, the 'Seat of Lightning', built stories in their respective realms, and died after fulfilling their missions.

「The Sun God.」

Some Apollos were revered as sun gods.

「God of prophecy and poetry.」

Worshipped for 'prophecy' and 'poetry'.

「God of music and reason.」

He also achieved fame for his art and intellect.

「Sharpener of the forest.」

He was once a renowned figure, the brother of Artemis.

[All your 'stories' prove you.]

All of these were his own history. But at the same time, they weren't his history. They were the stories of other Apollos of the past—the first, second, third—up to thirteen generations.

「Rebirth is the number, and all twelve seats must reprove themselves.」

Hermes, the 'Master of the Skywalk'—who had inherited his own story for the seventh generation—advised him with pity.

[Poor Apollo. Unfortunately, you in this generation were not born with exceptional talent.]

Over the course of fourteen generations, Apollo accumulated a vast number of stories. However, having many legends didn't necessarily mean a Constellation was strong.

Unnecessarily bloated legends sometimes threatened the Constellation.

The 'Tale of the Bow' ignored him, the 'Tale of Prophecy and Poetry' favored Hermes, and the 'Tale of Music and Reason' ignored him.

Only the 'Tale of the Sun' protected him, but that wasn't enough.

[This generation's Apollo is a lousy one. He's been around for quite some time, and he still hasn't discovered any new stories?]

[What a waste of his sullen appearance.]

[Why not become an idol for the <Star Stream>?]

Amidst the evaluations of the other twelve Constellations, Apollo silently carried out his scenarios. He sometimes followed the orders of the 'Seat of Lightning', and like the other Constellations, he also had incarnations. However, due to his lack of discernment in identifying incarnations, the incarnations he chose all died before even making it to the scenario stage.

[Tsk tsk, if only the 13th Apollo had been astute.]

As his failures continued, Apollo became more and more intimidated. His actions became more timid, and he participated less frequently in higher-level scenarios.

Despite being criticized as the 'Incompetent 14th', he never gave up on finding his own incarnation.

「I just need to find one good incarnation. If I can find one who will pioneer the story for me, I will be free from incompetence.」

Then, by chance, he discovered the incarnation Daphne, the one the 'River God' had been interested in. Apollo, enamored with Daphne, continued to court her.

[The Constellation, 'Almighty Sun', wishes to welcome incarnation 'Daphne' as its incarnation!]

But Daphne rejected Apollo, and even hated him so much that she requested a 'deus ex machina' from the 'River God', becoming a laurel tree and breaking free from her contract with him.

"You damn stalker. I'd rather be a tree than have someone like you as my sponsor."

After that, a story arose for him.

[The story, 'One Abandoned by the Tree', consoles you.]

Perhaps it was then that he began to hate trees. But who would have thought he would suffer such a miserable fate within a tree?

'Damn tree.'

Apollo, barely regaining his strength, took a deep breath and gazed at the battlefield.

More than half of the Five Hundred Generals were already incapacitated.

[Stop him!]

[Kwaaaaak!]

A man, covered in blood, roamed freely among the Constellations.

[The story, 'Noble War', trembles.]

Apollo belatedly remembered his nickname.

「The Puppet of the Oldest Dream.」

The incarnation of the Korean Peninsula, called 'Supreme King' by the Constellations of the <Star Stream>.

「A being known to defy the time of Chronos.」

Even within <Olympus>, there were attempts to recruit him. Even the noble Master of the Skywalk didn't stop courting him, trying to lure him into the gates.

When he first heard the rumors, he thought the theories were exaggerated. He assumed they were just stories made up by zealots who loved to rave about the incarnations.

However, the moment he witnessed Yoo Joonghyuk's actual battle, Apollo forgot his own situation and was lost in a fleeting moment of emotion.

「It's beautiful.」

There is a story that captivates even the gods' aesthetic sense. The life of a mortal who overcame the jealousy and hatred of the Constellations and ultimately ascended to their throne. His story illuminated the battlefield.

「I envy him.」

A being who alone could become the 'protagonist' of a complete story. That man—Yoo Joonghyuk—existed.

That's why Apollo was jealous of him, hated him, and revered him all at the same time. Because he wanted to become like that man.

With the end of the world fast approaching, he was no longer the protagonist of a story.

「He couldn't, like the Third Apollo, slay the evil Python.」

「He didn't have enough followers to build temples and spread prophecies like the Fifth Apollo.」

「He couldn't, like the Seventh Apollo, attain the power of healing and purification, and incarnate Asclepius, the god of medicine.」

「He couldn't, like the Eighth Apollo, disobey his father.」

「He couldn't, like the Eleventh Apollo, make love to Calliope, the wife of Muses.」

Their most glorious days were past, and there were no two hundred left in this universe for Apollo to be the protagonist.

And yet, he remained a mortal sin.

「I want to build a story.」

He wanted a proper story, not just a half-assed one. A story of his own. A story where he was the protagonist. A record that could be retold in this <Star Stream> for eternity.

Reading Apollo's desires, his father, the Seat of Lightning, offered this advice.

[Then become a myth.]

These were the words of a great Constellation, already a myth.

[If you become a myth, you will never be forgotten in the <Star Stream>.]

From that day on, Apollo lived to become a myth.

He obtained fragments of the 'Oldest Dream'. He gathered Constellations of the same caliber.

To create a story that would never be forgotten, he revamped the destruction scenarios and nurtured the 'World Tree' that would survive the destruction.

[Halla! Vidar! Where are you!]

Finally, his myth was on the verge of completion.

If only it hadn't been for the appearance of that damned incarnation.

[Apollo.]

Halla and Vidar, already writhing with their bodies destroyed, called out to him.

It was only one incarnation. To that one incarnation, all the Constellations approaching 'mythical level' were defeated.

[We must run. That thing is a monster. Take us quickly…]

At that moment, Apollo understood his role.

「If I can't become the protagonist of a story.」

Apollo slowly bent down and grabbed Halla's head.

[Apollo?]

His right hand moved in an instant, ripping Halla's head off.

「I will become the villain, infinitely closer to the protagonist.」

Vidar, seeing this, crawled away with a shocked expression. Apollo grabbed Vidar by the back of his head and, as expected, ripped off his head. Grabbing the heads of the two gods, Apollo's gaze revealed his artificial sun, half-shattered.

「To become a 'sun' that will be remembered forever.」

Apollo embedded the heads of two Narrative-grade Constellations into his artificial sun. Fueled by the new Contellations' stories, his artificial sun began to burn red.

[Some Constellations in <Olympus> have noticed your evil deeds!]

[Some Constellations in <Tamra> condemn your actions!]

[The Constellations in <Asgard> are showing hostility toward you!]

His story began to be tainted with the criticism of the Constellations.

[The story, 'Lover of the Muses', is deeply disappointed in you.]

[The story, 'Light and Reason', is deeply disappointed in you.]

…

Apollo abandoned the history he had built. He abandoned the history of rewarding good and punishing evil, and he abandoned the reputation he had built as the god of light.

And so, all that remained for him was desire.

「To become a myth.」

The Five Hundred Generals who witnessed Apollo's atrocities roared from all sides.

[The omnipotent sun has gone mad!]

Apollo laughed.

His story was repeating itself.

[It should have been this way from the beginning.]

The 'Fragment of the Oldest Dream' possessed by Halla and Vidar was being transferred to him.

The power to understand the essence of this world.

As his consciousness expanded, Apollo felt the presence of a thick 'wall'.

The wall where all the stories of this world were written.

He was being recorded on that wall.

[The Constellation, 'Almighty Sun', rises greatly in rank!]

A sense of overwhelming freedom began to dominate his entire being. Passing the boundary of the mythical level, his consciousness leaped high above the wall. Yoo Joonghyuk, noticing the change, was running towards him, but he paid him no mind.

Yoo Joonghyuk had already vanished from his sight. At that moment, he was gazing upon the highest point of the sky.

[Father.]

Now he felt he could call the name he had never dared to call.

[Zeus, Seat of Lightning! I have arrived!]

At that moment, Apollo left his body and entered a completely different realm.

He had once heard a story. There was a place only the great 'Mythical Constellations'—those who had long perfected their narratives and reached their own conclusions—could reach.

「He blinked, and there was a round table.」

Mythical Constellations sat at a large round table. Even the Constellations of the mythical order, those that created a world, were staring back at him.

The Island That Conceived.

The Spear That Demarcated the Seas.

The Master of December 25th.

The One Responsible For the Cycles of the Universe.

The Master of Abydos.

…

Apollo shuddered at their gaze and approached the round table. At its edge sat the Constellation he admired.

[I can finally see your seat.]

The great 'Seat of Lightning' turned to him.

This was the position of mythical-level he had longed for.

There was one empty seat at the round table. Apollo realized it was his seat and approached it.

It was only when he placed his hand on the back of his chair that Zeus spoke.

[You cannot sit there.]

Since when had it been? All the Mythical-level Constellations had been glaring at him.

[This isn't your place.]

With a terrible pain, his soul began to be pushed out of the Round Table.

Apollo's lips twitched. But the Round Table wouldn't even allow him to speak.

'Why?'

At the last moment, Apollo saw a white-faced man taking the empty seat he had assumed was his.

'Why—'

It was a man he knew well.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 950 Episode 56 Myth (2)

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With a terrible thunderclap, Apollo felt his soul shatter. At the last moment, he reached out once more.

「The man was definitely a face he knew.」

Strangely, however, Apollo couldn't tell who the man was. Was he the 'being' who had fed him flesh and blood, or the 'child' who had interfered with his plans for the World Tree? Or was it a 'different being' that was neither here nor there?

「The mythical Round Table scattered like dawn before Apollo's eyes.」

Apollo howled as he opened his eyes, as if waking from a trance.

[Father—!]

Yoo Joonghyuk, running across the battlefield of the annihilated scenario, swung his sword.

"I am not your father."

The sharp blade grazed Apollo's shoulder. Apollo let out a pained scream as fragments of the myth flew.

[Ah, ah, ahh—]

It was the throne he had longed for.

A mythical throne. The epic of the eternal stars.

That story vanished right before his eyes, forever beyond his reach.

[Ahhhhh!]

All of Apollo's stories began to run wild. From the first life to the fourteenth life. All his stories were screaming with pain.

[The Constellation, 'Pure Moonlight Hunter', warns!]

Appolo's eyes, lost in his rage, darkened, as if he hadn't even heard his sister's warning.

「Corruption.」

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned.

The Constellation's corruption was on the verge of reaching mythical proportions. The implications of this phenomenon were clear.

[A new 'Demon King' is about to appear in the <Star Stream>!]

Demon King. Demon Kings had appeared in the <Star Stream> countless times before.

But has there ever been a case where a Constellation belonging to the twelve gods of <Olympus> became a Demon King through 'Corruption'?

[Demon King, 'Creator of Discord', cannot hide his excitement!]

[Demon King, 'Unfathomable Severity', welcomes the new Constellation's corruption!]

Since when, the Demon Kings themselves have been observing the scenario through their own retinue.

Apollo burst into maniacal laughter.

[Yes, if I don't ascend to 'myth'—]

Bearing the gaze of the demon kings, who would have normally despised him endlessly, Apollo accelerated his decline. In the mind of the 'Almighty Sun', his long-held stories

lamented.

「He was once a warrior who defeated the medicinal dragon.」

「He was a man who loved prophecy and poetry, and adored Yuzu.」

「He pioneered the art of prophecy, benefiting the mortal race, and even challenged his great father...」

Yoo Joonghyuk had heard the story too. Yoo Joonghyuk gazed at Apollo with his blazing eyes, and said,

"They say you can only reach certain realms by abandoning all the stories you've accumulated."

Apollo frowned, as if deeply offended by Yoo Joonghyuk's words. How could a mere scribe understand the sorrow of a Constellation? How could a mere mortal comprehend the despair of having to throw away all his stories in the blazing heat?

"But that's how you will reach the realm you desire."

The moment Apollo saw the story embedded in Yoo Joonghyuk's swordsmanship, his mouth fell open involuntarily.

"Do you think the ending you desire will be there?"

The story embedded in the swordsmanship was wailing.

The sorrow of losing someone. The regret for a past unchangeable.

The moment he heard the voice of a distant story, unbelievable to have been built by a single human, a realization struck Apollo.

[You.]

The human before him was one who defied the time of Chronos. A being who alone, rewinding the time of this world, lived his life.

[You truly understand my story.]

Sometimes, a Constellation finds great comfort in the mere fact that a story similar to its own exists in this universe. Apollo felt the same way at that moment. The moment he was

understood by the mortal he had despised and ignored, he felt both profound joy and despair.

「This was his ■■.」

To end his life in a contest with the only living being in this world who could understand him.

He had lost track of the profound story. Apollo declared.

[I will do my utmost, Puppet of the Oldest Dream.]

The artificial sun began to burn with pitch-black flames. One by one, the Constellations began to cast their gazes upon the fallen incarnation.

[The Constellation, 'Pure Moonlight Hunter', sinks into deep sorrow.]

[The Constellation, 'Speaker of Justice and Wisdom', turns its gaze away from the sun.]

[The Constellation, 'Master of the Skywalk', records the brother's final appearance.]

[The Constellation, 'God of Wine and Ecstasy', falls silent at the brother's final moments.]

The Constellations of Olympus watched Apollo's end.

The flames of the artificial sun consumed everything in the forest. The incarnation, the stage, the Constellations. Waves of light overflowed from Apollo's entire body, as if he himself would be consumed by the blazing flames.

[Kaaaaaaah!]

[Damn Apollo! Stop!]

Seemingly ignoring the other Constellations, Apollo continued to spew flames.

[A Natural Disaster-level Fear, the 'Impossible Justice', is in agony.]

It was clear that if this continued, the entire forest would be engulfed in flames. Yoo Joonghyuk focused his magical power on his sword.

「The Regressor began to run, slashing at the encroaching flames.」

With each sword thrust, the sound of divine history shattering could be heard. A fierce flame, powerful enough to incinerate even the Constellations of the stories of the Gods, engulfed his entire body.

"This level of flame."

But even Apollo's flame, which could burn even the Constellations, could not consume the Regressor's soul.

"I've experienced it countless times."

The indomitable spirit, unfazed by anything, sundered the flames and reached the artificial sun.

Yoo Joonghyuk plunged his broken sword into the artificial sun without hesitation. With a roar, the mirror shattered, and the artificial sun, too.

[The story, 'Noble War', concludes its storytelling.]

As the sun, imbued with the stories of the Blood Demon and the Heavenly Demon, shattered, the stage effect ended.

Apollo, having lost the sun, gazed at him.

[You are indeed strong, Puppet of the Oldest Dream.]

Despite losing the sun, Apollo's dignity remained intact. As if he could recreate that mere sun over and over again, a new 'artificial sun' was forming behind him.

Yoo Joonghyuk replied without any change in expression.

"I will destroy it as many times as you want."

[Yes, that is how you have lived.]

At that moment, Apollo's eyes became clouded. With eyes that once loved 'prophecy', Apollo was reading the story of the Regressor.

[But unfortunate puppet. You will never reach the end you desire.]

"That is not for you to decide."

[You will be eternally unhappy. With such a brilliant story, at the end of this world, you will be the most terrible of all. You will face tragedy. So—]

The completed artificial sun gradually inflated and once again spewed black flames.

Apollo, gracefully stepping back, threw himself into the sun and said,

[I will save you from this place.]

The ocean, guiding the black flames, soon swallowed Apollo's incarnation body and rose into the sky.

Apollo, who had become the black sun itself, spoke,

[Remain here with me as an eternal 'story'.]

Black flames blanketed the sky in black. In the black flames, where even breathing was difficult, Constellations, unable to withstand the scorching heat, began to fall.

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at the black sun with a grave expression.

Now, even the effects of 'Staging' were gone.

Jaehwan's warning rang in Yoo Joonghyuk's ears.

「"Remember. You cannot use 100% of your power in soul form."」

Even if he used the ultimate power of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship], it seemed difficult to bring down that sun.

That meant only with a 'sword'.

「You must not use a 'spear'.」

Yoo Joonghyuk took a deep breath, and the shape of a long spear appeared in his right hand.

He remembered his promise. But even if he had to break his promise to Jaehwan, he had a duty to avenge his master here.

「Just once is enough.」

Perhaps because the technique hadn't yet been perfected. His right hand, condensed with stories, began to tremble precariously.

[Many Constellations are astonished by your power!]

It wasn't a technique he could show them anymore.

But just once...

Kugugugugu!

The black sun spewed out a corona. The rippling wave of flames instantly covered the sky and surged down to the ground. It was faster than expected, and Yoo Joonghyuk's face hardened.

「Time is running out.」

Yoo Joonghyuk bit his lip, aiming his unfinished spear at the sun. A cool shadow fell before his eyes, and he suddenly felt a sense of relief.

「Something was blocking the sun's flames.」

A vast forest loomed before his eyes.

No, perhaps it would be more accurate to call it a forest?

「A forest made of a single tree.」

He could see Fears rising within the pitch-black shadows.

【Ooooooooooooooooooo】

The Fears that slumbered beneath the forest's surface. The shark, at the center of those Fears, was approaching him, boasting its streamlined body.

[Catastrophe-level Fear, 'Tooth Fin', reveals its majesty!]

The Constellations in the sky emitted light as if in shock. The man's blond hair sparkled in the starlight filtering through the forest's shadows.

Yoo Joonghyuk chewed on the bright hair, looking at it. He muttered.

"You're late."

The man replied with a smile.

"You're the one who's late, aren't you? If you'd rushed over when I contacted you, this wouldn't have happened, right?"

The two men stared at each other for a moment, then simultaneously looked up at the burning forest sky.

The eight-year reunion was brief.

「Because, for the past eight years, their goals have been the same.」

A brightly shining story began to envelop the two.

[The potential of a 'giant story' is about to blossom.]

The sound of writing on the wall could be heard.

"How much stronger have you become? Can you kill a Mthical Constellation now?"

「Kim Dokja asked.」

"If I use a spear."

「Yoo Joonghyuk answered.」

"Is that so?"

Of course, he reacted as if he expected that level of power from Yoo Joonghyuk.

Seemingly displeased with that response, Yoo Joonghyuk quirked his thick eyebrows and asked,

"How much stronger have you become?"

"Me."

The man looked up at the sky in silence. Yoo Joonghyuk joined him in looking up. Strangely, at that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk felt he couldn't quite grasp what the man was looking at.

"Still not enough."

Perhaps that's why, Yoo Joonghyuk instinctively called the man's name.

"Kim Dokja."

The black sun's flames began to encroach through the shadows of the show.

Yoo Joonghyuk continued.

"Once we defeat that bastard, that's when the real war will begin."

He knew it without even asking.

Probably by now, the Constellations of each Giant Nebula outside the World Tree would have swarmed to capture them.

"If we fail this time—"

"The world will end."

Kim Dokja spoke calmly, and Yoo Joonghyuk glared at him. Kim Dokja shrugged and smiled.

"Aren't we people who are used to destruction anyway?"

「Perhaps only Yoo Joonghyuk in this world understood Kim Dokja's joke.」

"No matter how many times you experience it, you never get used to it."

「Likewise, only Kim Dokja understood that it wasn't a joke to Yoo Joonghyuk.」

"I know."

Finally, as if the time had come, the shadows of the forest began to open again. The fears of those who cried out in unison. Kim Dokja spoke in harmony.

"It's time to go see the conclusion of the final round."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 951 Episode 56 Myth (3)

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Since the outbreak of the 'Destruction Scenario', the incarnations of small and medium-sized corporations, who had been stationed in the southern region, finally began to move.

"Let's save the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

The Constellations of the companies, sensing their movements, also sent indirect messages to the incarnations.

[The Constellations belonging to the Nebula <Black Cloud> warn the incarnations!]

[The Constellations belonging to the Nebula <White Cloud> scold the incarnations, telling them not to act rashly!]

Normally, the incarnations of the companies would have been frightened by the Constellations' messages. But today's incarnations were different.

"Hmph, you cowards who couldn't even descend to the scenario region—"

"Get out! It's embarrassing to have been affiliated with your company!"

The incarnations knew now.

Those Constellations would not interfere with the 'New Murim District' scenario.

[The Constellations supporting small and medium-sized businesses are greatly perplexed by the incarnations' reactions.]

Right now, a 'destruction scenario' was unfolding in the 'New Murim District'. If this scenario were to be confirmed as a disaster, the Constellations caught up in the scenario would face eternal destruction, along with their own legends.

「Constellations fearing eternal destruction will abandon the scenario from the moment the 'destruction scenario' begins.」

On the other hand, the incarnations gathered in the southern district of the 'New Murim District' were ones who had prepared themselves for even such a death.

Rather than choosing another 'sponsor', they chose to remain in this 'New Murim District' and witness its end.

Nevertheless, they still hesitated.

「What if this truly is their final battlefield?」

It was then that someone's cry rang out.

"The expansion of technique has stopped!"

The power of Fear emanating from <Tamra Junggong> was weakening.

"The power of the technique is weakening!"

It was Namgung Myung who spoke those words.

The incarnations nearby, coincidentally, questioned Namgung Myung's words.

"The technique's power is weakening? Is that true?"

"How do you know that? Who are you?"

The people asked, and Namgung Myung, who had been hesitating, stepped forward.

"I am Namgung Myung, the head of the Namgung family."

"Namgung family…"

A short sigh escaped the martial arts community at the mention of the now-extinct family. Everyone here remembered the name.

"The head of the Namgung family. I heard you were infected by the legends of the Outer Gods. You're still alive?"

"They say you can sense the power of Fear, and it's true."

"I've heard of the Namgung family's reputation. Eight years ago, during the Fear Realm incident, he was the one who fought until the very end."

Short murmurs erupted everywhere. Confused eyes, one by one, focused on Namgung Myung, and someone asked.

"Namgung sohyeop, do you have something to say to us?"

He asked that question not because Namgung Myung was the strongest incarnation here.

「They needed a justification.」

The incarnations who had been protecting the 'New Murim District' until now were now without a place to go.

They were tired of searching for another 'sponsor'. They had somehow managed to adapt to the 'New Murim District', but not because they loved the new Murim, but because they could not leave this land.

"All of you gathered here were once 'Murim people'."

For their sake, Namgung Myung opened his mouth.

"I often miss Murim, but I cannot bear to say that the Murim I remember was a good place."

The crowd listened to him in silence.

"The 'Murim' I remember was brutal. The weak were despised, and the powerful ruled everything. Where today's corporations once stood, there were powerful families. There were many who acted violently because they possessed martial arts prowess or had supporters."

A few of the incarnations nodded. They, too, remembered those days.

"But even in a forest overflowing with such rascals, stories were ours."

Namgung Myung's gaze slowly swept the crowd. There were those who had once been members of the Five Great Families or the Nine-Fold Faction, and the remnants of the Blood Cult or the Demonic Cult. There were also martial artists from small and medium-sized sects who had fought for regional hegemony.

Now, in a world where all those groups had vanished, people stood on a single stage.

"Even as we harmed or saved each other, fought or reconciled—that forest was undeniably 'ours'."

Throughout the long history of martial arts, the forest had been a stage solely for humans.

「The stage humans had lost.」

Someone bit their lip, and someone lowered their head in shock.

Only then did the incarnations realize what they had lost, and one by one, their anger erupted.

"I don't know what corporation you all gathered here belong to. However, if you were at least martial artists, please don't ignore this world's aspirations. Please—"

As if sensing their anger, Namgung Myung spoke.

"Please protect this breath."

The martial artists raised their heads and looked toward <Tamra Junggong>. It wasn't the Murim they remembered. Nevertheless, at that moment, the incarnations all recalled the same story.

"We will likely die. Perhaps this place will become the ■■ of which the Constellations speak. But even if that happens—"

Namgung Myung turned his back and began to move toward <Tamra Heavy Industry>.

"I want to see my end as a martial artist here."

With those words, a cheer erupted.

The martial artists began to run toward the forest.

"Reclaim the God of Murim!"

"Let's save the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint!"

"Everyone, follow the family head!"

Namgung Myung also roared with an agitated expression. Perhaps he knew this was all a futile endeavor.

Nevertheless, this stage was the last tribute the current incarnations could offer to the forest that protected them.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', cheers on the incarnations of Murim.]

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', immerses himself in the scent of the old Murim.]

[The Constellation, 'Last Ark', encourages the incarnations of Murim.]

Some Constellations sympathized with the will of the Murim people, and from somewhere, Recorders who showed interest appeared.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', begins to record.]

[Some Recorders join the record of the 'New Murim District.']

Have they heard rumors that a 'Giant Story' will be born here? The Recorders, who had arrived belatedly to offer even a single sentence, were recording the lives of the incarnations.

「The 'Impossible Justice' has already ended.」

As the forest's power weakened, the 'justice' that had brought them together vanished. Now, no one was forcing them to agree.

「Still, the martial artists ran toward the forest.」

It didn't matter who had ignited the fire in their hearts. At this moment, they were the forest's indigenous people, fighting to protect their ancient homeland.

[Fools. Retreat!]

A bolt of fire fell from the sky, and several martial artists running at the forefront were slaughtered.

[The Constellation, 'Ruler of the South Sea Dragon Palace', issues a fiery command!]

The South Sea Dragon King, a legendary Constellation from Tamra, was warning the incarnations.

And that wasn't all.

Some of Tamra's Five Hundred Generals had not ventured deep into the forest. And the Constellations of other major corporations were gathered at the forest entrance, keeping the incarnations in check.

[The Constellation, 'One Who Became a Saint in a Day', frowns.]

Among them was a Constellation from <Asgard>.

A Narrative-grade Constellation from <Asgard>, dispatched in a hurry after hearing that contact with Vidar, the 'Terminator of War', had been lost.

[Vidar, what a pitiful goal.]

The 'One Who Became a Saint in a Day'—Bala—calls out, carelessly detonating the rushing incarnations.

[South Sea Dragon King. How long will it take to seal it?]

[Preparations will be complete soon.]

[Hurry up. If the Myth-grade Constellations invade, everything will be in shambles.]

Not all Constellations feared the 'destruction scenario'. Some even saw 'destruction' as an opportunity. The Narrative-grade Constellations gathered here were no exception. Growing the World Tree to reach 'mythical' status would be a good strategy, but if that proved difficult, sealing the World Tree for practical gains wouldn't be a bad idea either.

「If they can just sort this out before the Mythical Constellations arrive, they'll be recognized for their efforts.」

The Constellations, gathered to feast on the crumbs of such a grand tale, unleashed their ferocious rage upon the humans.

[Get out, you insects.]

Namgung Myung glared, watching the incarnations melt before his eyes.

The Murim people, barely gathered together, were dying in vain.

He had to clear a path somehow. All these deaths couldn't be in vain—the moment he reached that point, someone clapped him firmly on the shoulder and stepped forward.

「Hair fluttering beautifully. A beauty with an androgynous appearance radiated vigor with every step, clearing the path.」

Along with the feeling that the surrounding air was being sucked in, a thunderous Lion's Roar, reminiscent of the mantra of a Constellation, rose and rang out.

[Where are my followers!]

Some of the Constellations, overwhelmed by the force, stammered out their words.

[W-what—]

[What the hell are all these weirdos gathered here! Are they throwing a festival without me?]

Savior Nirvana.

The strongest ascendant, having recovered from his injuries, stood at the forefront of the Murim community.

"The Savior has arrived!"

As Nirvana's [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara] began to slaughter the Constellations in front of him, the Murim community, their spirits lifted, continued their charge.

The South Sea Dragon King, watching this, asked the surrounding Constellations,

[What the hell is that guy?]

[He's an incarnation of the Buddha.]

[The Buddha? Did that old islander have such an incarnation?]

No matter what the Constellations babbled, Nirvana pushed forward without hesitation, plunging through the waves of Constellations.

「I must find my disciple.」

That sentence alone dominated his mind.

「He didn't know why, but the moment Nirvana was carried by the disciple, he felt something like an old longing.」

In a hazy memory, the disciple's voice carrying him into the manor.

「"You're resting here, aren't you?"」

Nirvana knew. The disciple had clearly been drawn in by this stage. So now, it was his turn, the church leader, to save him.

Kugugugu.

It was then that a harsh vibration rose and spread through the forest. For a moment, the forest's interior split open, releasing a sage.

[Huh? What's that smell?]

Nirvana instinctively raised his head and muttered in a commanding voice. Slowly, his eyes began to dilate. It was unmistakable. There was no way he could have confused the scent of this story.

[Ahahahahaha! Yoo Joonghyuk! You're finally here!]

An excited Nirvana wandered through the forest.

He continued to run towards it.

The Constellations stopped him as he ran with a mad expression.

[Hold on.]

A torrent of ripples, resembling waves, swept over Nirvana, and a mass of magical energy reminiscent of Mount Tai fell upon his head.

Nirvana, fully activating [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara], roared.

[You damned bastards! The Supreme King is there! He came to meet me!]

Nirvana was a powerful incarnation. However, the Constellations were too numerous for him to handle alone.

Finally, he, who had been on the defensive, gathered the palms of [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara] and received the power of the Constellations.

"Move."

An incarnation leaped forward, using his [Thousand-Armed Avalokitesvara] as a stepping stone.

The momentum of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] slicing through the sky.

Nirvana's complexion brightened.

[Mad Sword Emperor! You're here!]

Jung Heewon's sword strike, slicing through the air, began to cut through the Constellations.

Jung Heewon roared, and Nirvana roared. But they could not defy the individuality of the Constellations.

The moment the seal, which had spread in ten hours, was about to cover the tree, a dog barked from somewhere.

「There was a lone individual there.」

Breaking the Sky Master let out a long question and leaped toward the seal. Kyung Sein, riding on her back, gained momentum and soared into the air.

「It was a very small gap.」

A small gap, like the gap between two sentences. Kyung Sein, who had squeezed into the gap, spread her arms and legs wide to complete the seal. She blocked it.

Tsutsutsutsut!

A fierce storm of probability swept over her, burning her entire body. Terrible pain surged through her, but Kyung Sein bit her lip and endured it all.

「Kyung Sein knew she wasn’t a great person.」

She wasn’t as sincere or outstanding as the other readers.

「But even she had scenes she wanted to see.」

Kyung Sein’s exclusive trait activated, and her entire body hardened like story metal. A level of hardness comparable to Lee Hyunsung’s [Steel Transformation].

「Kyung Sein used all her D-Coins to strengthen her incarnation body.」

Some might say,

"The Kyung Sein used all the D coins he had to strengthen his incarnation."

Someone will say.

Didn't you just read this story once?

「"Can't I like a story that I've only read once?"」

With Cha Yerin's voice in her head, Kyung Sein's story began to unfold.

「"There’s no need for qualifications to like something, right?"」

Perhaps reading a story is simply… It doesn't just mean reading the story.

「"But why do you, Judge, like Jung Heewon?"」

「"Ah, that's right."」

Memories of staying up all night chatting with unknown people. People she met simply because she happened to like a certain story.

「The history that created the current Kyung Sein was there.」

"Euaaaaaaaaaa!"

All the stories she had accumulated resisted the seal of <Tamra>.

The South Sea Dragon King, his expression hardened, gave an order to the Five Hundred Generals.

[Kill her.]

Arrows slashed through the air.

The arrows of the Constellations struck her cracked skin. Despite spitting out endless streams of crimson blood, Kyung Sein remained conscious. Blocking the narrowing passage, Kyung Sein resisted, and resisted.

The end of this world was predetermined.

She knew it, and perhaps all the other readers knew it too.

「And yet, if there were just one loophole.」

Someone, upon that margin, drew a different interpretation. If only they could write it.

"CEO!"

Namgung Myung's shout was heard from afar.

The moment she saw Namgung Myung's expression, Kyung Sein smiled bitterly.

「She truly realized she had entered a novel.」

She was in that story.

「She will never return to the world she once belonged to.」

Sentences were being written just for her.

「She will never see the next chapter of this story.」

Namgung Myung's expression, the astonishment of the Constellations, dictated the next sentence.

「Kim Dokja of the 'New Murim District' will lose his 'precious thing'.」

With the sound of [Fate] coming from somewhere, Kyung Sein's body began to crumble little by little.

Her vision was charred black by the aftershock of probability. Her body disappeared like a page torn by someone.

However, there was a certain sensation enveloping her.

As if written just for her, someone was carefully holding her in his arms. Now, blind, Kyung Sein could not see his face. There was none.

「She could only 'read'.」

The sound of a seal breaking.

Beyond the seal, Fears were awakening.

Amidst the shadows of the forest, ancient Outer Gods soared, flapping their wings repeatedly.

[A new 'Giant Tale' has been born!]

Fear began to howl, devouring the Constellations in the sky.

[Giant tale, 'Forest of Stars and Humans', has been born.]

Reading the sentences that seemed to end in a flash, Kyung Sein imagined another version of herself somewhere, reading this entire story.

In that world, she would be reading this scene, biting or laughing, rejoicing or saddened.

Without a single clue as to how long it had taken for these words to be born, she would simply blink like an excited Constellation. Without even knowing whether she liked this story or not, she would simply read the next sentence.

「That day, deep in the forest, a myth was born to stand against the Constellations.」

Imagining herself like that, Kyung Sein followed the story's end with eyes that could no longer see.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 952 Episode 56 Myth (4)

It didn't take long to defeat Apollo.

He was a Constellation who had reached 'mythical' status through a leap of faith, but he couldn't properly control his own rampaging stories

[I—]

As the 'Fears' arising from the Forest of Fear roared and charged, the black sun's corona shattered.

The pitch-black sun listlessly shed stories that weren't its own. Vidar's and Halla's stories let out resentful cries.

「And then Yoo Joonghyuk's sword moved.」

The blade gliding gracefully sliced through the dazzling light. For a moment, the sunlight was disrupted, and Apollo's face appeared through the split shadow of the black sun.

"I envy you all."

Apollo's voice, even the strength to utter his mantras, vanished. Watching Apollo, about to leave, I briefly considered another possibility for him.

"If it were another world—"

He was still a villain in the 40th round.

But I didn't bother telling him that story. Instead, I said,

"Yes, maybe it would have been different in another worldline."

I don't know if that comforted Apollo. However, in his final moments, he looked at me with a strange expression.

「A god who hunted evil spirits and passed down prophecies and poetry for humans.」

Surely, such a worldline exists. However, in this one, his role was merely a medicine man.

Sugagak!

Apollo's legend crumbled under the simultaneous sword strikes of me and Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The Constellations of the Nebula, <Olympus>, remember the end of the 'Almighty Sun'.]

The Constellations scattered, and the black heat that had threatened the forest subsided.

[You have achieved an incredible feat!]

[You have acquired a new story!]

As soon as I defeated Apollo, stories poured from the air.

I saw the roaring Fears around me chomping down on a few fallen story fragments.

[A vast amount of 'Loss' has been collected.]

[The 'Loss' you have collected is recorded on the Final Wall.]

The 'Kim Dokja Fragment' Apollo held was also absorbed into me.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins to devour!]

A faint heat bubbled near my heart.

Memories possessed by 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

「If we are the same Kim Dokja, why is there a distinction between the real and the fake?」

Perhaps this was what motivated Apollo.

Following this, the scenario interpretation reward message also appeared.

[You have successfully interpreted the 'Impossible Agreement', a Catastrophe-level Fear!]

[Interpretation suggestion: Trees and wine, a small shade for humanity under the sky.]

[You are possessed by the power of Fear.]

I felt the power of the 'Impossible Agreement', a Catastrophe-level Fear, seeping into me.

[Sub-scenario—'Eradicating Fear' completed.]

[You have earned 2,000,000 coins as a sub-scenario reward.]

The extraordinary reward details made feel amazed for a moment.

Even so, a sub-scenario rewarding millions of coins?

Considering the coin inflation caused by D-Coins, it's understandable, but...

[You've acquired an exclusive trait as an additional reward for completing the sub-scenario.]

[You've acquired the exclusive trait, 'Abyssal Understanding'.]

[This trait greatly increases your affinity for stories!]

[Your understanding of unfamiliar stories greatly increases!]

And now, I've even got an exclusive trait.

The trait I just received was exactly what I needed.

[The main scenario content has been updated!]

[You have acquired 500 additional tributes!]

The 500 tributes were a reward from the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' in this 'main scenario'.

Only those who acquired this tribute could escape through 'Ascension' in the 'Ascension Scenario'.

[You currently have the 'most tributes' in the scenario area.]

However, the 'Impossible Agreement' was no longer a scourge of Murim. In other words, the incarnations no longer needed to acquire tribute to escape the 'Destruction Scenario'.

[The 'Destruction Scenario' is currently in progress in that region.]

So, it would be natural for the 'Destruction Scenario' to be withdrawn soon...

But is the scenario still ongoing?

Amidst a sense of foreboding, Yoo Joonghyuk, having collected the scattered stories, quickly approached. He glanced around the spot where the deep sun had disappeared and said, "I'm going back now."

Where the sun had vanished, a swirling portal appeared. Perhaps if we ventured out there, we could escape the forest.

"I understand. You came in spirit form, didn't you?"

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

If 'Midday Tryst' was far enough to not reach properly, then Yoo Joonghyuk must have been somewhere separated from this area, both in time and space.

"Still, I see you received the message."

"You sent a story."

I sent a story about the 'Returnee War'. To be precise, I intertwined the story of the 'Returnee War' with Yoo Joonghyuk's [Fate].

「The long-returned one will return to the forest ruled by the Constellations.」

It was a gamble I could take, knowing that Yoo Joonghyuk would never abandon his master, no matter the circumstances.

"But this time, it's too late."

We were staring at the spot where Breaking the Sky Sword Saint had just moments ago. The figure that had been shedding pitch-black tears had vanished.

"Breaking the Sky Sword Saint's soul was never here."

"Was it a thought form that remained here?"

I nodded.

This 'Fear' was originally a condensation of the stories Breaking the Sky Sword Saint left behind. Her soul had likely left the scenario area long ago.

Perhaps it was the price of her thoughts and true stories evolving into 'Fear'.

「"I always been late."」

[Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], activated in real time, was reading Yoo Joonghyuk. Even in such a vast shadow, Yoo Joonghyuk still couldn't rest.

He knew I was reading him, yet he didn't show it.

"Have you acquired the forest?"

The only consolation I could offer him was to record this horrific story to the end.

"To a certain extent."

I felt the 'forest' of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint stirring within my shadow.

The Fears that emerged from the forest included those on the scale of a Natural Disaster, including the 'Toothed Fin'.

The Fears bared their white fangs at me.

Yoo Joonghyuk, staring at these Fears, said,

"It couldn't have been easy."

Indeed, I nearly died fighting those creatures. Strictly speaking, I couldn't say I was handling them properly.

"I could talk for half a day if I wanted to."

I added, gazing at the distant passageway in the sky.

"I guess we'll have to wait until next time."

In the distance, I could see the portal entrance gradually narrowing. The situation was clear.

「Someone is deliberately narrowing the passage.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, sensing the situation, hardened his expression and said, "It looks like they're trying to seal this place completely."

"I have a rough idea of what they are."

Apollo, Vidar, Halla, and numerous other Constellations had fallen victim to this 'World Tree'.

But a scenario of this scale wouldn't have been planned by just three Narrative-grade people.

The Constellations they'd plotted with would have made their move by now.

「We have to get out now.」

I knew it instinctively. If I didn't escape now, they'd keep me trapped here until this round's ■■ arrived.

I looked around and saw Yoo Joonghyuk's soul body vanish. Having exhausted all the given probability, he was returning to his original location.

"Let's meet again."

Yoo Joonghyuk replied,

"Survive."

It was a brief greeting for a reunion after eight years. But it was enough. We knew each other were alive, and we knew we were struggling to see the end of this world.

「All that remains is to confirm the stories we've built so far.」

I launched [Way of the Wind] with full force and ran. The surrounding scenery was pushed back.

I leaped into the portal. Time and space felt distorted, and in the distance, something blocked the narrowing entrance.

「"Why do you like Jung Heewon?"」

Story fragments drifted through the air.

「"That's..."」

I felt a deep symphony.

「"Strange... Why can't I remember..."」

Cracks appeared between the faintly glowing incarnations. The arrows of the Constellations penetrated through them.

I reached out and embraced her.

"Sein-ssi."

Kyung Sein, whom I held weakly, closed her eyes. I couldn't say thank you or sorry. At that moment, a single emotion dominated me.

「I want to shatter all the Constellations in the sky.」

Stories began to overflow from my body.

[The Constellation, 'First Heavenly Demon', can't take its eyes off you.]

[The Constellation, 'Maritime War God', can't take his eyes off you.]

[The Constellation, 'Bald Commander', can't take his eyes off you.]

The Constellations I knew were watching me.

[All the Constellations of the Nebula <Olympus> are watching you.]

[All the Constellations of the Nebula <Asgard> are watching you.]

[All the Constellations of the Nebula <Vedas> are watching you.]

My enemies too.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Fox Who Commands the Sky', records you.]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Prince of Wolves', records you.]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Demon King of the Cinema', records you.]

Even Recorders who devour this story. And—

「And there was a single reader of this story.」

Looking at the sky, ablaze with bright starlight, I finally understood how this entire story began and how it must end.

「The stage opened.」

The shadow of a giant pine tree spread across the floor.

[The story, 'King of Fear' begins its storytelling.]

With a piercing sensation in my back, gigantic wings spread out as if to protect me.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', begins its storytelling.]

The Fears began to unfold. Fears of Catastrophe, Disaster, and Natural Disaster level, all reaching out toward the Constellations. Among them, the one who took the lead in biting the incarnations was 'Toothed Fin'.

【TeethTeethTeethT

Beings abandoned by the scenario and turned into 'Fears''

I had only one promise to make to them.

「"I will show you the ■■ of this world, too."」

Just a small space. An ancient fear was rising above that space.

The World Tree of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint grew into a pitch-black shadow, piercing the starry sky.

[The Constellation, 'Ruler of the Southern Sea Dragon Palace', cannot hide his surprize.]

The Constellations pierced by the branches of the World Tree writhe, spewing out stories.

「The world born from the blood of the annihilators will despise the old heavens.」

Several Constellations, sensing the strange turn of events, began to retreat into the darkness.

[Some Constellations are preparing an emergency scenario exit!]

The ruler of the South Sea Dragon Palace, belatedly realizing the situation, pointed at me and spoke.

[Don't panic, everyone! If we catch him, it'll all be over. He's just a single Narrative-grade incarnation. He...!]

The Constellations that had been rushing towards me were devoured by the Fears that erupted around me.

Glancing at the fading starlight, the South Sea Dragon King's mantra subsided.

[He...!]

A massive spark ignited throughout my body. I desperately used my unique traits and stories to quell the aftershock. With a calm expression, I walked towards the Constellations.

It was then that I felt a strange sense of urgency.

「I felt a sense of being watched from a gigantic round table.」

Simultaneously, a change occurred within me.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', has completed its predation.]

[Your 'Kim Dokja Fragment' count has exceeded the critical threshold.]

The Constellations screamed in the sky stained with fear. The Constellations that once enjoyed stories were no longer there.

「And thus, the story that the Constellations fear was born.」

I approached the South Sea Dragon King.

The South Sea Dragon King, whose entire body had been bitten by the Outer Gods, pointed at me, spitting out stories.

[How.]

The creature staggered back, overcome by the poison, and began to shout.

[How! A Constellation, a being not even human, by a being that didn't even make it to the final scenario, how on earth could…!]

The South Sea Dragon King, who had been speaking up to that point, fell silent.

My image was reflected in the Constellation's eyes. The Constellation's emotions were transmitted in real time through its swaying eyes.

Shock, grief, and awe.

[Could it be…]

The blade of 'Unbreakable Faith' slashed at the creature's neck.

「The Constellations must see this.」

I raised my head, suppressing the endless stream of stories swirling within me.

「They must know that this story has finally reached this point.」

Only when I reached this high sky did it begin to sink in.

Even though so many Constellations had fallen, the sky was still studded with countless Constellations.

[All the Dokkaebis of the 'Management Bureau' exceptionally acknowledge your 'rank'.]

But now, only a few twinkle above me.

[The <Star Stream> announces your 'rank'.]

I slowly turned around and saw the Fears staring up at me. Forgotten things, barely able to record their own sanctity in the fleeting moments, howled and prostrated themselves before me.

[Your rank is 'Mythical'.]

With a feeling like a hazy veil was being lifted, the message came.

[You have earned the right to witness the world's ■■.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 953 Episode 56 Myth (5)

The Demon King of Salvation scanned the headlines on the newspaper on the table.

『Today's Kim Dokja』.

The newspaper was worn and torn here and there. Nevertheless, it remained faithful to his duty: to tell Kim Dokja's story.

「It's been a long journey.」

Several kkoma Kim Dokja, seeing the sentences neatly appearing on the newspaper, had tears in their eyes. The Demon King of Salvation looked at them for a moment and said,

「(It's not over yet, so don't make a fuss about it.)」

Just because he'd reached mythic status, it didn't mean it was over. The Youngest had never failed to reach the realm of myth in the fights he'd faced.

Furthermore, the Youngest had less time accumulating stories than them, so he was bound to be at a disadvantage in actual combat.

「(We was lucky this time, but...)」

A stage adaptation of「Returnee War」. If even one of the three—the World Tree of Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, and the appearance of Yoo Joonghyuk—had not been in place, the Youngest would have lost his life in this fight.

Furthermore, the help of the recorders who actively protected the Youngest's records was also significant.

[The Recorder of Fate, 'Unchanging One', assists the 'Rewriter of Eternity' in his records.]

One was the assistant Recorder the Youngest had taken in: And—

[The Recorder wearing a scale mask assists the 'Rewriter of Eternity' in his records.]

The other... seemed to be one of the Recorders the Youngest had met in the 'Record Archives'. He was likely nicknamed 'Moral'.

「Whenever you need it, call upon this 'Moral', just once. I will assist you.」

Even then, he had shown favor towards the Youngest, so it was not surprising that he assisted in this record. In any case, it could only be explained by good luck.

「Come to think of it, Kim Dokja's stories were always like that.」

A scenario where even the slightest deviation would lead to certain death. The Demon King of Salvation finally recalled the time when he had finally become a 'Myth-grade Constellation'.

「(You don't even remember, do you?)」

Turning his head at the reprimand, he saw the face of the Second, who had been sleeping, his blanket rolled up like a mat.

The Demon King of Salvation chuckled at the Second, who blinked absentmindedly, and gestured to the newspaper with his chin.

「(The Youngest has finally reached the Myth-grade.)」

As if he already knew, the Second Kim Dokja—the King of Fear stretched slightly and stood up. The Second, who had flown in with his fairy-like wings fluttering, examined the words the Youngest had left behind.

「In the shadow of the World Tree, the Outer Gods roared. As if searching for their roots, their history, their lost origins.」

The Outer Gods who had accompanied the second in the Fear Realm were there. The forgotten beings of the <Star Stream>. The Fears, having lost their 'Time Fault' and their hiding places, finally exhaled in the Youngest's shadow.

「(I'm sure that's not the Fear Realm you dreamed of, but...)」

The King of Fear read and reread the sentences on the newspaper with unreadable eyes. He discerned the blank space beyond those sentences—the breath of the Outer Gods nestled within the shadow of the vast World Tree. Only then did he exhale softly and say,

「(They aren't forgotten.)」

The Fear Realm was destroyed, and the world the King of Fear dreamed of vanished. Yet, the Outer Gods were still recorded in this story.

「This was the Youngest's story.」

A story too eloquent to be described. The Youngest's story was neither a narrative of 'Salvation' nor a narrative of 'Fear'.

However, it could be expressed this way. If someone had written everything in this world, yet something remained unwritten—the Youngest would be the one to write that 'leftover blank space'.

Both Kim Dokjas knew this well, and therefore, they understood that the Youngest would inevitably be the protagonist of this worldline.

「(This is where it's going to get really tough. Now that the Youngest's status has been revealed, the other Constellations won't sit still.)」

The Youngest had grown stronger, but he was still practically alone. Meanwhile, the other Constellations already possessed immense power.

「(Not only Mythical Constellations, but even Outer Gods from distant worldlines would have noticed the Youngest's presence.)」

The birth of the 'World Tree' was an equally momentous event. A story that embodies the birth and destruction of a world. The Youngest had seized the power of the World Tree, and those who would surely target him would emerge. And most of all...

「(Now he'll make his move, too.)」

The King of Fear nodded slightly at the words of the Demon King of Salvation. At that moment, every Kim Dokja present was thinking of a single Kim Dokja.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja.」

The mastermind behind this world's story, the Demon King of Salvation, and the King of Fear, had both encountered him before.

「(One strange thing.)」

The King of Fear spoke, and the Demon King of Salvation nodded, as if already knowing.

「(Why didn't he intervene in the Youngest's case?)」

Given the circumstances surrounding the intervention of Constellations like Agni, Vidar, and Apollo in the 'New Murim District', 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was clearly aware of the 'World Tree Scenario'. Nevertheless, he remained hidden until the scenario concluded.

「(Perhaps he needs the Youngest, too.)」

The Demon King of Salvation thought. If 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' hadn't intervened in this case, it meant this was the case he wanted.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja wants the Youngest to become stronger.」

The reason wasn't clear.

Perhaps the Youngest's presence was necessary for the ending he desired.

The King of Fear, who had been contemplating something nearby, suddenly spoke.

「(Perhaps that's not the only reason.)」

The Demon King of Salvation turned to the Second as if he asking what he meant, then flinched and realized something. All eyes of the other Kim Dokjas, excluding the King of Fear, were focused on the incident.

「All Kim Dokjas were focused on the incident.」

It made sense. This incident was the largest the Youngest had ever caused.

But here's the problem.

「(All Kim Dokjas.)」

The Demon King of Salvation, his face flushed, pulled out his smartphone. He immediately pressed the '3' button.

「The Third Kim Dokja must have witnessed this incident, too.」

He hadn't expected the Third to answer. He was always in airplane mode, and he knew he'd hear a message saying the phone was off or in a no-call area.

Nevertheless, the Demon King of Salvation dialed the number with a strange premonition, and to his surprise—

The ringtone began ringing.

Someone answered the phone with a 'call', followed by an unidentifiable noise and a scream.

「(Hello? Is this the Third?)」

And—the voice of the man who once answered the phone in place of the Third.

—...We...need...

Continuing with a distorted voice, the call ended. But that was all it took for the Demon King of Salvation to realize what had happened to the Third. Glaring at the disconnected call, the Demon King of Salvation slowly raised his head, his expression tinged with faint anger.

「(That bastard has discovered the coordinates of the 'Third'.)」

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[The 'Destruction Scenario' is currently in progress.]

I stared blankly at the message that was repeatedly echoing through the air.

Even after the main and sub-scenarios had concluded, the message of the 'Destruction Scenario' continued unabated.

Namgung Myung, who was also looking up at the message, muttered,

"Maybe it wouldn’t be bad to continue living in longing."

Namgung happily told everyone about it, as if he had gained some profound insight from the message. As if this was the moment they had all been waiting for.

"Our Murim was liberated from the Constellations by facing destruction."

Three days had passed since the 70th main scenario ended. During those three days, I practiced handling the 'World Tree' and observed the status of the new 'Giant Tale'.

I also checked the scenario rewards. Some of them would be of great help in future scenarios.

However, I deliberately left some of them unopened. I decided to save them just in case, in case something happened in the higher-level scenarios.

「People no longer used D-Coins.」

The martial artists who had relied on D-Coins now seemed to be struggling to regain their former Murim.

They voluntarily returned their D-Coins, and I used them to grow the World Tree.

「Watching the people rejoicing at the liberation of Murim, Kim Dokja felt a strange sense of alienation.」

Perhaps the reason I didn't feel any particular emotional turmoil while watching them was because I had now become a being slightly different from an ordinary human. I briefly contemplated the round table that seemed like a hallucination the moment I ascended to the myth-grade, then turned to Namgung Myung and said,

"What happened to Sein-ssi?"

"Ah, Divine Doctor is waiting."

With Namgung Myung's help, We were able to invite Divine Doctor, who was in another scenario area.

As we headed straight to the Namgung family's manor, Divine Doctor's face came out to greet us.

"It's been a while."

Divine Doctor smiled brightly, as if remembering me. I had been indebted to him before entering the Fear Realm.

After a brief handshake, I asked about Kyung Sein.

"How is she?"

"Unfortunately..."

As expected. Even Divine Doctor's power seemed too much to restore Kyung Sein. I went straight into the manor to examine her condition.

「Kyung Sein's incarnation body was in a truly dire state.」

Her incarnation body was pierced by the arrows of the Constellations, pierced with holes. The malice of the Constellations stained Kyung Sein's entire body black.

"Dokja-ssi."

Kyung Sein slowly opened her eyes and looked at me.

"I'm fine. Don't try any harder."

"..."

"You know it's not just a wound, right?"

Since we first met, Kyung Sein's 'soul' had been damaged.

It was as if a part of her soul had been ripped away by someone. Perhaps it was a scar left when 'Kim Dokja fragment' she possessed was taken.

And who could possibly do something like this...

"Is that from Snowfield Kim Dokja?"

Kyung Sein shook her head weakly at my question.

"No."

Kyung Sein took a deep breath and spoke in a straight, precise voice.

"I gave it to him."

She gave it to him. Kyung Sein said.

"Dokja-ssi, I think you're right, but I don't think he's wrong either."

I knew what Kyung Sein meant.

"But can that be the reason your reading should end?"

Kyung Sein coughed.

With each successive attack, her incarnation body gradually opened. At this rate, her incarnation body would dissipate in less than thirty minutes.

I had no intention of leaving it like that.

[Preparing exclusive skill, 'Special Preservation'!]

I had summoned Divine Doctor to buy three days of time in order to use this skill I learned from Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd round.

"Don't worry, Sein-ssi."

[Special Preservation.]

A skill that sealed a near-death incarnation body, delaying its demise.

"You will not die."

It wasn't my favorite method. Nevertheless, this method, used by Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd round, was the only way to prevent her death.

After hearing my brief explanation, Kyung Sein asked,

"If you use that, my time will stop, right?"

"Yes."

"No."

I hadn't expected Kyung Sein to say that, so I was taken aback. Kyung Sein lightly grabbed my hand and continued.

"Then I won't be able to read this story."

I was about to ask what she meant. For a moment, I felt Kyung Sein's grip tighten. A faint, yet powerful emotion flickered across her retina.

"I heard a story about a library."

"…"

"A library only the 'Kim Dokjas' who entrusted their lives to you can enter."

I stared blankly down at her. Who on earth had told her that?

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', chuckles.]

The culprit was clear.

「Perhaps some reading doesn't end even after the reader dies.」

Kyung Sein smiled at me.

"I want to enter that library too."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 954 Episode 56 Myth (6)

My stomach churned. Kyung Sein's body was gradually becoming transparent. The stories floating above her surface were speaking to me.

「I want to read.」

What kind of feeling is it to want to read something? Where does the desire to sacrifice one's life, to expend one's entire existence, to understand someone else, come from?

「Just because I was born into this world.」

Reading something, being moved, rejoicing, or feeling sorrow, spending a lifetime. I still don't understand why this series of actions exists and continues.

But humans are born that way, and Kyung Sein and I will live that way too.

"Understood."

Kyung Sein's face brightened at my words. In the dispersing light, Kyung Sein's stories began to slowly be absorbed into me.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', begins to feast.]

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

"Thank you, Dokja-ssi."

Stories flowed from Kyung Sein's body as she slowly closed her eyes.

「The place where I first met that person was Geumho Station.」

It wasn't as old as the legends of the Constellations, but it was a legend nonetheless.

「The person who existed only in novels was truly before my eyes.」

The door to the manor opened abruptly, and someone entered. She knew who it was without even turning around.

"Sein-ah."

Jung Heewon, her voice trembling, sat down and looked down at Kyung Sein as she disappeared.

Kyung Sein couldn't see Jung Heewon. However, her story continued to speak.

「I learned from that person's tenacity. I learned how to overcome hardships, and how not to despair easily.」

Jung Heewon grabbed Kyung Sein's wrist with a trembling hand. Kyung Sein's scattered story spread like sunlight across the back of Jung Heewon's hand.

「I learned not to give up hope even after death.」

Scenes flowed through the margins between sentences.

「I learned how to willingly hold the hand that was extended. Even if the fingertips were as sharp as blades, I learned the courage to grasp them.」

The history of Jung Heewon's life, a history built layer by layer to save others—and herself—was there.

「That was her reading.」

Kyung Sein desperately imagined someone who existed only as a sentence. With each sentence of Jung Heewon's story, Kyung Sein's life expanded.

「"I am Jung Heewon."」

Some people can live simply by loving someone. They gain strength from it and overcome life. Perhaps that is their myth. And the manifestation of that myth was right before my eyes.

[Story, 'Heewon' dwells within you.]

The story that finished its storytelling took hold within me.

Kyung Sein had probably arrived at the library in the [Fourth Wall]. There, with an innocent expression, she would be reading this story with the other Kim Dokjas.

"Dokja-ssi."

「Jung Heewon called me. The moment I turned to look at her, my heart felt tight, as if it had been clogged. Perhaps it was because I had acquired Kyung Sein's story.」

"Sein-ah."

The story, which had drifted like a reverberation, lingered in the corners of my heart and then disappeared.

Jung Heewon reached out, as if groping for the air. I looked at her hand, lost in its direction, and replied,

"Sein-ssi will continue reading this story."

I couldn't tell whether Jung Heewon would understand. Nevertheless, I had to say it. Jung Heewon heard it, and answered me in her own language.

"I will take revenge."

A strong grudge flickered in Jung Heewon's eyes as she raised her head.

"This world that has brought Sein to this—I will end it."

I started to say something, then simply nodded.

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I shook my head at the words of Namgung Myung and the Murim people.

"There's no need for that."

From this point on, this wasn't a scenario that ordinary incarnations could enter. That's precisely why the special scenario jump method called 'Ascension' existed.

"In higher scenarios, the pressure of the incarnation body itself is different."

Stories also have gravity. The larger the scenario area dominated by the incarnation, the greater the pressure on the incarnation body.

If Namgung Myung, without the [Fourth Wall], had mistakenly entered a higher scenario, he could have lost the pressure and his head could have exploded.

"I know it's a burden."

Nevertheless, Namgung Myung and the Murim people's resolve remained firm.

"Still, there might be a way."

With those words, Namgung Myung turned toward the World Tree.

[Natural Disaster-level Fear, 'Impossible Justice', is looking at you.]

The essence of the World Tree, left behind by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, had been assimilated into my shadow, but the form of the World Tree still remained on this 'New Murim District'.

Namgung Myung stared into the interior of the form and said,

"Yesterday dawn, I discovered a peculiar place inside the World Tree."

A peculiar place. The moment I heard the story, I somehow knew what Namgung Myung would say.

"There was a place inside the bushes where time flowed slowly."

After the fall of the Fear Realm, the Murim people lost the way to enter the 'Time Fault'. The training ground where they could cultivate within the overwhelming density of time and level up their realms had disappeared.

But within that World Tree, a place to replace that 'Time Fault' existed.

I looked at Namgung Myung, strangely aroused, and said,

"You know it's reckless, right?"

"The Murim people are reckless people by nature."

Namgung Myung was now talking about becoming a Transcendent. I tried to offer Namgung Myung some advice, but stopped short. He seemed to already know what I was talking about.

"I will definitely come to help."

Namgung Myung's words were true.

Those who dedicated their lives to ascending to a higher realm, to attaining the ultimate in martial arts through sheer effort. They were Murim's people.

As I raised my head, I suddenly felt as if a vast forest was looking down on me.

[The giant story, 'Murim', is watching you.]

A forest thick with mortal history—a forest that has long continued the story of this land.

As I gazed at that forest, it occurred to me that perhaps the transformation of the Murim people was also a legacy passed down by Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

"Before you leave, Divine Doctor has asked you to stop by briefly."

I nodded briefly and headed straight to the manor where Divine Doctor was.

The manor of the Namgung family. As I entered the manor, I saw the Namgung family, reunited around Namgung Myung, rebuilding the manor here and there.

I remembered briefly staying here with Yoo Joonghyuk during my first visit to Murim.

"Are you there?"

At my message, Divine Doctor came out. Perhaps because he had been nursing all night for the past few days, his complexion was pale.

"The Salvation Leader hasn't woken up yet."

Divine Doctor was in charge of Nirvana's treatment.

"But he's a strong incarnation, so he'll recover quickly. It's not like his core was damaged."

I owed Nirvana a debt. If I hadn't met him in this scenario, things would have been difficult.

"But are you really planning to move up to the higher scenarios?"

"Yes."

"It wouldn't be a bad life to just stay here and act as king. Everyone would follow you."

"That's not why I came all the way here."

Divine Doctor looked at me intently, then asked with a faint smile,

"You've become a Recorder of Fear, haven't you?"

As expected, Divine Doctor had noticed.

I nodded, and Divine Doctor asked again,

"Do you understand the stories better now?"

When I first met Divine Doctor, he had said something like this to me:

「"To control the stories, you must know them well. How much do you know about them?"」

I faithfully followed Divine Doctor's advice back then. To look into them to understand them, to think about them constantly, even when I was sleeping or doing other things.

"A little."

"Hmm, is that all?"

The moment those words left my lips, the stories stirred within me.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', is looking at you.]

As I absorbed more Kim Dokja fragments, as 'Heir' grew stronger, a certain image emerged within me.

A man in a white coat with a pleasant smile. He liked to look up at the sky, but also liked to lower his head to read. As the image became clearer, something inside me felt like it was fading.

I called the man's name in my head over and over again. And as I did, the name seemed to draw closer to me. Closer, closer, closer, until finally, it erased my own name and replaced it with—

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', powerfully activated!]

When I came to my senses, Divine Doctor was staring at me with startled eyes.

"I'm sorry. I was distracted for a moment."

Divine Doctor lightly squeezed my shoulder as if it were all right.

"Some stories, the longer you look into them, the more you lose track of whether you're looking into them, or they're looking into you."

"Still, I can't stop looking, can I?"

"You must not stop."

"Are you living like that, too?"

Instead of answering, Divine Doctor simply chuckled. Then he raised his head and gazed at the sky.

"Now, you can see the secrets of the heavens, too."

The secrets of the heavens. Perhaps that's how Divine Doctor described the vast flow of stories surrounding this world.

"The atmosphere is ominous. The sky is too quiet."

I agreed.

After the conclusion of the 'New Murim District' scenario, all the Constellations observing the scenario area disappeared.

As if someone had artificially carved out this world.

I tried calling Bihyung, wondering if something had happened to the <Star Stream>, but he didn't respond.

"It must mean the situation in the higher scenario is dire. They say 'Ragnarok' is imminent."

"Maybe that's not the problem. I think—"

Divine Doctor's words trailed off. Before they could continue, someone burst through the gates of the manor.

It was Namgung Myung, who had left to investigate the area near the Ascension Hall earlier. Judging by his expression, something unusual had occurred.

"Benefactor, we have a problem."

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The main scenario of the 'New Murim District' was originally completed when an 'Ascendant' of a certain rank ascended to a higher-level scenario.

Each corporation actively supported these ascendants and welcomed them as allies in the higher-level scenarios.

In other words, this 'New Murim District' was a kind of barracks where the Nebulae would develop their next generation of forces.

[Your corporation is '■■■ Company'.]

[You have met all the requirements for Ascension.]

To be precise, that was the case until I arrived here.

"They say all the Orbital Elevators required for 'Ascension' have been removed from the higher-level scenario area."

I knew that the Orbital Elevators had once been destroyed by Mad Sword Emperor Jung Heewon. But this time, the orbital elevator infrastructure itself had been demolished in the upper scenario area.

"Is there no other way to ascend?"

"There is a way, but..."

According to Namgung Myung, the Nebulae operating each company can summon ascenders from the 'New Murim District' using their own probability.

"Normally, if you recall the name of your company in the Ascension Hall, you'll receive a response from the upper scenario area..."

My company is '■■■ Company'.

"No response, right?"

"Yes."

That must mean that those affiliated with my company in the upper scenario area aren't looking for me. Thinking about that, I felt a slightly ominous feeling.

"I'll just go to another area and find a way to reach the upper scenario area."

"That's also difficult right now. The portals leading to the old Fear Realm and the passages connecting to other scenario areas are all cut off."

For a moment, I couldn't believe my ears.

"All the passages are cut off?"

"Yes. As if someone had intervened... In effect, the 'New Murim District' is now isolated from the <Star Stream>."

It was then that I realized what was happening.

「Kicking the ladder away.」

The moment I ascended to the 'mythical' level, the Constellations in the higher scenarios must have sensed my status.

And some Constellations probably didn't want me to ascend to the same scenario as them.

Jung Heewon, who was watching from the sidelines, growled.

"You're saying they're going to prevent him from even ascending."

"Benefactor, I'm sorry, but if this is the case, there's only one way out."

I knew what Namgung Myung was trying to say.

「If I change my company, I can advance to a higher scenario.」

The Constellations were telling me now.

If I want to advance to the next scenario, choose their 'Nebula'.

Of course, I had no intention of playing along with them.

"No, there's a way to advance to the next scenario without changing my company."

"Huh?"

"Because there's still a passageway connected to the outside world."

"What—"

I pushed Namgung Myung's doubts aside and continued walking. Namgung Myung suddenly muttered, realizing where I was going.

"Benefactor, you can't possibly…"

"That's right."

There was just one 'passageway' that even those powerful Constellations couldn't stop. That was because it was beyond the power of the Constellations.

"Ah."

As I entered the auction house, Jung Heewon sighed, as if she had realized my intentions. Where my steps had stopped, there was a giant scale.

「Settlement scale.」

The scale occupied the center of the Auction House. The 'settlement system' of this 'scale' was clearly connected to the 'outside'.

「It's a form of Fear, but it's a Fear that isn't under the influence of the 'King of Fear'.」

As I stared at the scale, I felt its eyes also staring at me.

「I thought I knew who the owner of this 'scale' was.」

A race capable of interfering with the scenario and freely borrowing and using the power of the 'other world'.

「The being who turned the ending of the 41st round into hell.」

"I request a deal."

At my call, I felt the being beyond the scales gaze at me.

"The Demon of the Horizon, no—"

Perhaps, this was the more fitting name for him.

"The Wenny King."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 955 Episode 56 Myth (7)

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The exact nature of the 'Wenny King' is not detailed in either the 'Way of Survival' or 'ORV'.

However, several clues about him clearly exist.

「A Constellation that enjoys changing genders.」

The first time the creature appeared in the main story was when Shin Yoosung of the 41st round emerged.

More precisely, when Kim Dokja possessed Shin Yoosung of the 41st round.

But its true identity was not simply that of a 'Constellation with a peculiar taste'.

「Anna Croft's Contract Holder.」

The entity that effectively brought 'Prophet Anna Croft' into being.

This very creature was the sponsor behind her receiving the 'Eyes of the Great Demon' and securing the backing of <Asgard>.

「The one who alters his own existence.」

That was one of his modifiers.

<Asgard>'s Star - The God of Mischief, 'Loki'.

But his true identity wasn't Loki. He was one who had wandered the <Star Stream>, endlessly shifting his existence, a powerhouse formidable enough to even check that 'Dokkaebi King'.

「[You've never heard this story, have you? It's not even preserved as stories now. Only the 'Apocalypse Dragon', driven mad by the repeated cycles of time, might barely remember it.]」

An existence as ancient as the primordial calamity, the 'Apocalypse Dragon'.

"You won't answer?"

I looked at the 'Settlement Scale' and spoke again.

「I have no certainty that the being beyond this is the 'Wenny King'.」

Nevertheless, several pieces of circumstantial evidence pointed to him.

「An entity capable of interfering with the scenario.」

「An entity that is not merely a Constellation.」

「An entity that can wield the ancient 'Fear' of another world and enjoys 'deals'.」

Considering these various conditions, several figures came to mind. But when imagining an entity capable of devising a treacherous device like the 'Settlement Scale', the category narrowed drastically.

"Seems you're not curious about what lies beyond the Final Wall?"

No sooner had my words fallen than a sinister aura stirred beyond the 'Settlement Scale'.

"That's why you're gathering the 'Kim Dokja Fragments'. isn't it? To peek beyond the wall. Constantly shifting your identity to interfere with the scenario, even antagonizing the Management Bureau—"

A thick, bloody stench began permeating the air. From within the scales came a sound like flesh being crushed. Realizing something was terribly wrong, Jung Heewon grabbed my sleeve.

"Dokja-ssi."

The moment I inhaled to respond, the world spun upside down. It felt like every piece of common sense I knew was being smashed into the ground. I was connected to something.

[The owner of the 'Settlement Scale' is watching you.]

Come to think of it, I'd had a similar experience when I'd caught a strand of hair in the scales before.

If my memory served me right, back then I'd definitely made brief contact with the 'Oldest Liberator'.

The 'Oldest Liberator' was the final form of Jecheon Daeseong, a Constellation that didn't exist in this worldline.

In other words, this 'scale' was also connected to the outside of this worldline.

「Someone's universe was there.」

A floating thread of truth whirled toward me

「Teeth-bite-teeth-bite-teeth-bite-teeth-bite」

I recognized that story immediately. It was the story of the fear I had tamed—the 'Tooth Fin'.

Why is this story here?

As I tilted my head in puzzlement, I spotted a small tag beneath the story.

「500,000 coins.」

500,000 coins?

Looking closer, I saw price tags attached to each story floating nearby.

「880,000 coins.」

「1,000,000 coins.」

「4,800,000 coins.」

Many stories were unfamiliar to me, but one installation stood out.

「"■■ah. We can ■■ the world."」

I stared blankly at the story's price tag.

「Valuing...」

Had this story not been priced yet?

As I bowed my head, I felt the threads forming my hands twitch.

「Every story in the world has a 'price' assigned to it.」

This seemed to be the law governing the 'space' within this scale.

In that instant, I suddenly wondered.

「Then how much value would 'I' be assigned here?」

As if reading my inner thoughts, I heard the sound of the scale's beam shifting in the darkness. Clang. The sound rang out. It rippled out like a bird's cry, deepening the folds across the entire universe.

And clang.

It sounded like a weight dropping onto a giant disc. Each time the sound echoed, the surrounding sacred flames flickered uneasily.

Thud. Thud.

The intervals between the sounds grew shorter and shorter.

Thud. Thud. Thud. Thud. Thud. Thud. Thud. Thud. Thud—

Soon, it swallowed every other sound in the vicinity.

The sound of something breaking. The moment when all of spacetime tilted and twisted.

[Enough.]

A mantra echoed through the darkness. It was a voice so unpleasant and cold it felt like it was tearing through the inner walls of my heart.

I heard someone ticking off a scale, like an alarm clock.

[Those who collect discarded dreams all have peculiar thoughts.]

In the silence that enveloped the area, the owner of the scale gazed at me with gleaming eyes.

[So, did you bring something more valuable than 'hair' this time?]

The moment I saw his face, several faces came to mind at once.

He looked like Ji Eunyu, or Dansu ahjussi. Or like Killer King, or like Yerin-ssi. Upon closer inspection, he resembled Kyung Sein.

And...

He also resembled me.

Or perhaps he wasn't any of them. For a moment, I realized something.

「The owners of those faces have all brought 'Fear' to the 'Settlement Scale' and appraised it.」

The people I confirmed were all readers whose names had been on the 'Appraisal Rankings'.

[Hmm, if it's difficult to appraise with the 'Settlement Scale', then that's a bit problematic...]

The faces that had seemed like different people in real time had become fixed.

It was Kim Dokja's face.

However, even though they had the same Kim Dokja face, I could now tell them all apart.

Looking at Kim Dokja's face, smiling brightly before my eyes, I recalled the record at the top of the 'All-Time Appraisal Rankings'.

| |
|---|
| 1st Place, Unidentified Fingernail Fragment, 10,000 D Coins, ■■■. |

As expected, the owner of that ranking seemed to be 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'. The 'Wenny King' before me had already met and traded with 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

[Since there's no answer, perhaps you've come to sell yourself? If so, you'll need to prepare a larger scale. The scales here aren't suited to your weight—]

"I have no intention of selling myself."

I quickly added.

"I've come to make a deal with you."

At the word 'deal', the Wenny King smiled inexplicably.

[Yes, what have you come to trade, fragment of the 'Oldest Dream'?]

I wasn't particularly surprised or flustered. There was no way a being of the caliber of the 'Wenny King' wouldn't know who I was.

The 'Eyes of the Great Demon' glowed crimson.

In his eyes, the past and future of this worldline trembled.

"What I'm dealing with is this."

I looked into his eyes and said,

"Your future."

[My future?]

The Wenny King tilted his head for a moment, then smiled with amusement.

[You know my 'future'?]

I recalled the final scenario of the main story.

In the final scenario, the Wenny King reached beyond the 'Final Wall' with the Dokkaebi King.

I clearly remembered his end.

"You."

He was a superhuman, beyond the norm, but he wasn't the main character of the story. Because of this, I could only understand a fraction of his records. But even in those few, I could clearly sense the emotion.

「A very ancient loneliness.」

The loneliness of someone who has lived for an excruciatingly long time in this vast universe.

"Aren't you living your whole life to glimpse beyond the 'Final Wall'?"

Constellations that have explored all the world's stories and still crave stories. Anyone who has gazed into the universe composed of such Constellations for a long time will inevitably ask the following question:

"Why do stories exist in this world?"

The Wenny King answered in a voice that revealed no particular agitation.

[That's a huge question. There is no 'being' who can answer such a question.]

I nodded. I, too, don't know the answer to that question.

"But there are things I can tell you. For example."

I continued, examining the countless clusters of stories floating in the darkness—the price tags.

"What lies beyond the 'wall' you once knew, and what became of you who saw it?"

This was a gamble for me, too. If I revealed this truth to the Wenny King, there was no guarantee that the very foundation of this universe wouldn't be distorted again.

"Aren't you curious?"

Still, I had no other means of bargaining. The Wenny King was one of the most powerful beings in this worldline, and there were probably few stories he didn't know. This knowledge I possessed was the only one he might have missed, even if only a little.

The Wenny King paused for a moment, as if trying to grasp my meaning. He then gazed at the tangled stories floating in the air and opened his mouth.

[Your brother also came to me.]

I nodded.

The brother he was talking about must have meant 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

He was Kim Dokja, who had come closer than anyone else to the 'Oldest Dream'.

If he had visited here, he must have come to trade something.

"What did he trade?"

I thought he might not tell me, but the Wenny King answered with an inscrutable smile.

[He asked me for one thing in exchange for his story. It was quite amusing to me. No one had ever asked me that before.]

"What was his request?"

[He asked me to make him a mere incarnation of the 'Scenario' in exchange for a portion of his story.]

Goosebumps slowly rose from the tips of my toes.

I had a vague idea of what 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' had been pursuing during the past eight years while I was gone.

[So I asked. You've already become closer to the being you desire. So why do you want to go back to the beginning?]

The story, floating in the air, spoke for me, the reason why Kim Dokja, who had become closer to the 'real Kim Dokja', returned to his incarnation body and tackled the scenarios at the end of the world.

I knew it, he knew it, and perhaps every other Kim Dokja knew it too.

「"Because I think it'll be more fun."」

A piece of floating fingernail—perhaps that piece was proof of Snowfield Kim Dokja's deal with the Wenny King.

I checked the price tag attached to the fingernail.

「Stop measuring value.」

The inability to measure value and the cessation of value measurement were completely different concepts.

In a voice as clear as the distinct difference between the two, the Wenny King spoke to me.

[Unfortunately, I have no interest in my own future.]

"Is it because it's more fun not to know?"

The Wenny King laughed without answering.

I reviewed the plan in my head. I had considered the possibility of the Wenny King reacting in this way. The only question was this: Is there another 'story' about me that the Wenny King might be curious about?

[But I am interested in the future you will see.]

Suddenly, I raised my head and flinched.

Since when had it been? The distance between me and the Wenny King had become incredibly close.

His 'Eyes of the Great Demon' shone brightly before my very eyes.

「Future Vision, the vision of this world's future.」

I wondered. Anna Croft couldn't read my future. So, what about the Wenny King? Will he see the end of this world I'm about to face?

[You, perhaps.]

For the first time, a faint tremble filled the voice of the Wenny King, who gazed at me with swirling eyes.

[Have you ever heard of a 'very large baby'?]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 956 Episode 56 Myth (8)

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The moment I heard that question, I remembered what had happened with Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd round.

「"There's definitely a 'huge baby' somewhere in this universe."」

Han Sooyoung said. She believed there was a 'huge baby' in this universe, and that baby, she believed, was the source of all these stories.

I stared straight into the Wenny King's eyes and asked,

"You're curious about the origin of this universe, aren't you?"

For the first time, a hint of emotion flashed across the Wenny King's face. A flicker of excitement flickered deep within his eyes.

[As expected, you knew.]

Despite living for so long, the King still loved stories.

[Did you hear it from her?]

Perhaps the Wenny King had already guessed I'd heard this information from Han Sooyoung.

I paused for a moment, then nodded and continued.

"That's right."

[That's right. At this point, she's probably the only one who's reached the truth of the universe.]

"You have that same expression on your face, don't you?"

[What do I look like?]

Like a child desperate to solve a question right now.

"You look envious."

The Wenny King smiled.

[Me? Do I really look like that?]

Looking at him again, he seemed less like a child desperate to solve a question and more like an old man who'd never wanted to know the answer.

Looking at that expression, I thought about the 'story' that would determine the end of this world—the ultimate dream of all Constellations.

「A Single Story.」

Completing a Single Story, dedicating it to the [Final Wall], and creating an immortal record.

The Wenny King before me, and the other Mythical Constellations, are probably living towards that conclusion.

But as that conclusion draws near, they will feel a complex ambivalence.

「The desire to know the end of a story, and the wish that it would continue forever.」

The fact that even the Oldest Beings in this world couldn't escape such instincts struck me as quite tragicomic.

[Did she say anything else?]

"I think I should ask that."

I shook my head and quickly added,

"What exactly is this 'huge baby' you speak of?"

The universe of the 'TWSA' I'm talking about began in the mind of a boy. Han Sooyoung wrote that, and I believe it too.

But Han Sooyoung, in the 1,863rd round, didn't think so.

「"Do you really think a mere boy's imagination could shape the universe?"」

Even if Kim Dokja, as a child, provided that 'imagination', the being who 'realized' it wasn't Kim Dokja. That was why Han Sooyoung proposed the concept of a 'huge baby'.

[You're foolish. You could have used that as an excuse to make a deal with me.]

"Don't you already know that I don't know?"

The Wenny King nodded, seemingly satisfied with my answer, and asked back.

[Aren't you afraid of knowing the truth of the world?]

The Wenny King looked up at the sky. Perhaps not, but in this <Star Stream>, there are few Constellations higher in the sky than that one.

I didn't know what world the Wenny King was gazing at, or what he felt as he took his last breath in the main story.

All I could see was the price tags of the stories piled high like snow on his history.

[That everything we knew was just a part of the Great Being's dream—a ridiculous stage he devised. Isn't it truly terrifying to realize that we possess no innate value or meaning?]

Listening to those words, I felt as if I could vaguely understand why he put a price tag on stories. I thought for a moment and then answered.

"I'm not afraid. I always think about it."

I recalled the world I'd lived in for a long time. Memories gradually fading as I entered the <Star Stream>. In that world, where scenarios, Dokkaebis, and Constellations were all fictional stories, people were still part of a stage someone had created.

On stage, people played the roles of good, bad, or the audience. From their respective positions, they argued, made mistakes, killed, or pointed fingers at someone.

They called the events on stage an inevitable reality, blamed the actors involved in the tragedy, and at the same time, indulged in it. They fueled their lives with it.

Thinking about this, I began to understand why Kim Dokja was so able to adapt to the world of 'Ways of Survival'.

Perhaps Kim Dokja survived in this world not simply because he was a reader of 'Ways of Survival' or because he was a master of the 'Fourth Wall'.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', nods at your thought.]

He was able to adapt so well to this world because he had already lived in the 'ruined world' before coming here.

The Wenny King tilted his head in confusion, perhaps sensing some sentiment in my response.

[Your brother said something similar.]

"What did he say?"

[He said there was nothing to fear, since it was an ending he had seen countless times.]

An ending he had seen countless times.

I couldn't fully fathom the feelings of Snowfield Kim Dokja, who had relayed those words.

[Even I don't know much about the huge baby.]

After a short pause, the Wenny King began to speak.

[I only guess that its existence exists beyond the distant wall, in the 'deep sea of ■■■', where the first records were created.]

The deep sea of ■■■.

It was a story I had once heard from the 'Recorders of Fear'.

"Why are you so readily sharing that information with me?"

He, who placed a price on every story, couldn't help but value the information I shared. So, the reason the 'Wenny King' was sharing it with me now was clear.

He believed I would reach that place someday.

With a dark smile on his face, the Wenny King nodded and said,

[If you ever visit that place, show me the scenery. That's the condition of my deal with you.]

"Do you know why I came to negotiate?"

[Didn't you come here to ask for a transfer to a higher scenario?]

As expected, engaging in a power struggle with a being of the Wenny King's caliber wasn't easy.

[The Constellations might complain, but I can send you and one of your companions to the higher levels with my own strength.]

He even knew exactly what I needed.

I smiled bitterly at the Wenny King and asked,

"Thank you. But did you ask my brother the same thing?"

The Wenny King gave a sly smile instead of answering. He probably meant he couldn't tell me that much.

[Are you willing to make a deal?]

"I will."

[Then let's get started right away. The timing isn't bad.]

The timing isn't bad?

[The Constellations and the Bureau were just distracted.]

I pictured the empty skies of the 'New Murim District'. Apparently, the sudden disappearance of the Constellations and the Bureau wasn't a coincidence.

"Is something happening in the higher-level scenario?"

[You have a knack for thievery. If you want to know that, you should leave something more significant than a hair.]

"Should I at least clip my fingernails?"

[If possible, how about pulling them out whole?]

We glared at each other, eyes narrowed, then simultaneously relaxed our expressions. Both he and I knew this deal couldn't go through.

[Just kidding.]

"I was joking, too."

I already felt uneasy about giving him hair, and I had no intention of giving him fingernails.

Licking his lips, the Wenny King waved his finger in the air, and a portal began to swirl and form. As I approached the portal, the Wenny King spoke, as if he'd forgotten.

[Oh, I almost forgot. I have a gift for you.]

"I'd rather not. Gifts like that usually end badly."

[Your brother gave it to me.]

I turned around and saw the Wenny King smiling at me, as if he'd expected me to. A small piece was spinning like a top at his fingertips. Just a glimpse from afar was enough for me to realize what it was.

「A fragment of a fingernail left behind by 'Snowfield Snowfield Kim Dokja'.」

The sublime quality of the story felt in the fingernail.

The Wenny King spoke with a hint of regret.

[I recently received this from the recorder recording his stories. He told me to tell him when you come here.]

My brother, too, seemed to have anticipated my search for the 'Wenny King' to advance to a higher scenario.

It wasn't strange.

Just as I was Kim Dokja, so was he. It was only natural that he was thinking what I was thinking.

"If it's a gift from my brother, I should accept it."

The moment I slowly reached out for the nail fragment he handed me, a fragment stirred within my heart.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', growls.]

Heir was wary of that fragment. The closer it got, the clearer the fragments contained within became.

A faint fear rose within me. Snowfield Kim Dokja had left such a story fragment here, even before the final battle of the worldline. His confidence was astonishing, and at the same time, I was curious about the fragments he had left behind, even at the risk of such a loss. The moment I finally read the first sentence of the story, which was right before my eyes,

「That day, in the 41st round, Kim Dokja returned.」

I realized what this story was about.

「"Who… are you?"」

「"Who do you wish me to be?"」

The story was about a protagonist.

「"I am Kim Dokja."」

And it was about the people who knew that protagonist well.

「"From now on, I will lead the scenario."」

I gazed at the rippling story with trembling eyes.

「Before me lay the myth of the past eight years, personally built by Snowfield Kim Dokja.」

Even without reading, emotions seeped through the margins of the sentences. They were the emotions of the people who had created this story together.

Listening to the voice of the Wenny King, I discerned glimpses of those emotions.

[If you don't want it, it's okay not to accept it. However.]

In the midst of the flowing emotions, countless people called out a single name.

「"Kim Dokja."」

People called out his name, rejoicing or mourning.

「"Kim Dokja?"」

They mourned or marveled.

「"Kim Dokja!"」

They sometimes admired him.

「"Kim Dokja..."」

Or they were relieved.

「There, unknown to me, were the eight years of Kim Dokja and his companions.」

The fingertips reaching for the story flinched. It was a first time I hesitated to read anything. Because,

「It seemed like there was nothing for me to write in this story.」

The Wenny King added, as if he found my reaction amusing.

[Your brother said you must have many questions, and that if you open the story, you will find the answers.]

My face was reflected in the Wenny King's red retina. An expression so clear and undeniable, it was impossible to deny.

And so, for the first time, I learned about myself.

[There are stories whose endings are so intriguing yet so terrifying to see.]

I have that expression on my face as I turn the last page of a book.

[So that's how the story is to you, Kim Dokja.]

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 957 Episode 56 Myth (9)

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I couldn't answer anything to the Wenny King's question.

All I could do was listen helplessly to the story's trailer, like a prisoner in a cage eating a rationed meal.

「"It’s the Demon King!"」

Only 8 years. During those eight years, my brother accumulated numerous stories.

「"A new Demon King has appeared!"」

In that story, my brother liberated the Demon King of the Demon World.

「"<Gigantomachia> will start soon!"」

「"Fight together!"」

「"Kim Dokja! Kim Dokja!"」

He went through the giant story of <Olympus> and liberated the giants of Tartarus.

「"It is a precursor to the Holy War of Good and Evil."」

「"If this continues, the apocalypse dragon will wake up."」

「"The battle between the demon world and Eden will soon begin. If you don't prepare for everything—"」

It wasn't just that. He killed the 'Seeker of End' group and prevented the outbreak of the Great War of Good and Evil during the Demon World event— 'Blue Witch's Night', which is one of the precursors to the Great War of Good and Evil.

「"Just like you and me, good and evil are just part of a grand story."」

He also personally led the Outer Gods who invaded the Constellations of the nebula and sent them back to the 'Island of the Reincarnation'.

「"Is this really what only one incarnation has accomplished..."」

Those who saw his stories revered or worshiped him. Or there were people who were jealous or in awe.

「"Savior..."」

And in the end, they were overwhelmed by one emotion.

「"He is the savior of the scenarios."」

A story blinked before my eyes. It was a story that deserved to be called an epic.

A being that all the stars and incarnations of this <Star Stream> will envy, having cleared a number of 'giant story scenarios' in just eight years and reached the realm of 'myth'—

My brother has become that kind of person in scenarios over the past eight years.

「But strangely enough, I felt sad about his story.」

The greater the sense of déjà vu felt in the story, the greater the sadness.

Why do I feel sad reading this story?

When I raised my head, the Wenny King was still waiting for me.

[Will you continue reading?]

A story that shines as if asking me to read it in more detail.

Perhaps if I read this story to the end, I will be able to get an important clue about my brother. And by absorbing this story, I will be able to get one step closer to the brother waiting for me in the higher scenario.

Nevertheless, I couldn't readily reach out to the story.

"I."

What would Kim Dokja do. No, as a reader before I am Kim Dokja, I wonder what I want to do with this story.

The light of the story was getting stronger. Finally, seeing how the story couldn't stand it anymore and was about to start its storytelling, I also opened my mouth.

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It was Jung Heewon who greeted me as I escaped from the residence of the Wenny King.

"Dokja-ssi."

Jung Heewon, who hurriedly ran, held my hand and asked.

"Where on earth have you been? You suddenly disappeared into the scales, and no matter how much I searched, I couldn't find you—"

"You've been waiting a long time, sorry."

Jung Heewon's right hand was fluttering with a golden sword. She looked back at the 'Settlement Scale' and said.

"I was just wondering if I should just destroy it."

Looking at Namgung Myung pouring out cold sweat behind Jung Heewon, it seemed like if I had come back a little later, the scale would have been split in two.

[The story, 'Destruction, Regret, Obsession', concludes its storytelling.]

"Why do you look at me like that?"

"Nothing."

I thought, avoiding Jung Heewon's gaze with a embarrassed face.

「What would Jung Heewon have become in the original 41st round?」

Even though we reunited for the first time in 8 years, we couldn't talk much about small things with Jung Heewon. We just kept each other's backs in the implicit belief that we had the same goal.

With Bicheonhori's consideration, I witnessed part of her life record, but that may not be all of the last eight years she spent.

「I wonder if this person’s life would have been a little better with the story I changed.」

Maybe it's because I went to the residence of the Wenny King. Complex thoughts never stopped. I thought I had done my best so far, but I wasn't sure if the path I had taken was really the right path.

"Who bullied you again?"

"Huh?"

"You look like you've been bullied by someone."

Jung Heewon was looking at me with a serious look. I looked back at her. Over the past eight years, faint scars had formed on her face. They were scars that were hard to spot unless you looked closely.

"Who is it? The Constellations? Olympus? Asgard? Vedas? Who should I beat first?"

"Heewon-ssi."

I'd merely called her name, but Jung Heewon suddenly frowned.

"Why? Are you saying something strange again?"

"Huh?"

"Aren't you in a desperate state, alone, like the tragic male protagonist?"

"..."

"That's right. Like, 'Now, it's really dangerous. We might have to risk our lives.' Will you still go with me?' That's what you're going to ask, right?"

Honestly, it was so direct that I couldn't say anything in response. Perhaps my expression was quite amusing. Jung Heewon's expression softened and she spoke.

"Why are you even asking? You already know the answer. You're just asking because you're genuinely curious. Or—"

Jung Heewon sighed as I hesitated, my lips quivering.

"Okay. Ask again. If you need confirmation, I'll give you the same answer as many times as you need. Until you feel safe."

"..."

"Until you can trust me. I'll answer you again and again until you trust me as much as I trust you."

What makes a person's heart? How can someone with such a strong and shining heart exist in this tragic world?

「Jung Heewon was there.」

No god, no Constellation can shape a person's heart.

The experience of risking her life for someone else. Her history of unwaveringly drawing her sword in the face of injustice, big or small, and protecting or failing to protect what was precious. Every choice she made must have made her shine so brightly today.

[A portal leading to the upper scenario has been created.]

The portal promised by the Wenny King swirled in the air.

We exchanged brief greetings with Divine Doctor and Namgung Myung, who had come out to see us off.

"Then shall we go?"

I said.

"Let's go."

Jung Heewon replied.

Stepping into the portal, we entered an elevator resembling a small capsule.

「Orbital Elevator.」

It seemed like The Wenny King, too, had his own 'Orbital Elevator'.

[Your 'ascension' credentials have been confirmed.]

However, perhaps because the equipment was older than the Constellations', the elevator creaked the entire way up. Perhaps the noise was amusing? Jung Heewon said.

"Didn't you ever feel that way when you were young? I was always afraid of falling when riding an elevator."

"I wonder if I could survive if I jumped when it fell. I often wonder that."

"Did you feel that way too, Dokja-ssi?"

"But these days, elevators are equipped with advanced safety devices, so they say they never fall."

"Really? They always fall in movies."

"That's just a movie."

The moment I said that, the elevator's jolt intensified. I wondered if it was really falling, but a cosmic landscape appeared outside the elevator window.

It wasn't the Star Stream we knew.

Scattered throughout the universe were not Constellations, but legends. Perhaps we were currently riding the 'Orbital Elevator' and passing through the domain of the 'Wenny King'.

Soon, legends came flooding back to me like a scene from a movie. They were legends collected by the Wenny King.

「"But would germs count as life? Aren't they invisible?"」

Surprisingly, some of the legends I recognized were familiar.

「"Isn't it true that God is invisible too?"」

Contemplating an ending so distant it was almost invisible, I was at Geumho Station that day. The events that had occurred with the Life Cult leader, Kim Cheolyang. My story began there.

「"Excuse me, what is your tendency? My name is Jung Heewon."」

「"I'm Cheon Inho."」

And then I met Jung Heewon. There was no way that story would just flow by at that exact moment. This must be some prank by the mischievous Wenny King.

Looking back, Jung Heewon was also watching the story drifting outside the window.

「"Shall we stand back to back?"」

「"If it's alright, may I ask you a favor?"」

Among them were stories of our shared journeys, where we had overcome life-threatening hardships together.

「He wasn't Jung Heewon's father.」

「He simply read this story, and was the spectator brought here. And yet, on this tragic stage, he spoke the single line he had rehearsed all along.」

There were also scenarios where, despite my best efforts, I couldn't protect anyone.

「"Well done. Heewon-ah."」

Jung Heewon's father. Hearing the final words of Sergeant Jung Moonho, possessed by a reader, I called out Jung Heewon's name once more.

"Heewon-ssi."

Jung Heewon turned to me. I thought, watching the stories flowing across her eyes.

「As Jung Heewon said, perhaps it was a question that didn't need to be asked.」

We've already overcome countless hardships together, and we know how strong the other is. We understand what they want to protect. And yet—even though we know each other—we still can't help but ask each other.

"Are you okay?"

I didn't ask if she was okay. Because I knew she wasn't. And she, knowing my feelings, answered.

"I'm okay."

We're not okay. Because we weren't okay, we asked each other if we were okay, and we answered yes. Whenever there was a void between us, we willingly filled it with each other's words.

That entire series of actions became a solid record of our actions.

"Since I first started following you, I've never regretted it."

That's probably how we ended up here.

"But you've got a strange story."

"That's because you keep making people angry."

We snickered at each other. I spoke again.

"Eight years have passed, and you're still the same, Heewon-ssi."

"It's only been eight years."

"Eight years is a long time."

What was going through her mind when she heard me say that? Jung Heewon stared blankly at my face and then said in a very serious voice.

"Yes. It's been a long time. Maybe it's enough time for someone to change."

It was as if she'd read my mind. Perhaps it wasn't I who possessed the [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], but her.

"But just because someone changes doesn't mean it's necessarily for the worse. You've changed, too. And so have I."

"That's certainly true. Perhaps I'm no longer the person the group remembered me as."

"So it'll be okay. You, me, and everyone else. Even though time has passed, even though we've become different people, the history we shared together hasn't changed."

Only after hearing those words did it occur to me that perhaps I'd asked if it was okay because I wanted to hear those words. Perhaps it was I who truly wanted it to be okay.

"Let's believe in that history."

"Thank you."

I recalled the story of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' that the Wenny King had shown me.

To the Wenny King's question of whether I'd read it, I shook my head and answered.

「"If this is truly an interesting story, I want to read it with them."」

Perhaps we'll go through the same things again. We might fight, get hurt, and lose something precious.

「Still, we'll read this story.」

We asked each other repeatedly if we were okay, sharing trivial stories.

"You seem so resilient most of the time, but at times like this, you secretly—"

Jung Heewon, her lips pursed, was about to add something when suddenly, The elevator felt like it was tilting.

"Dokja-ssi," said Jung Heewon, her face flushed.

I felt an unusual vibration in the elevator. I nodded, watching the floor sway precariously, as if it might fall at any moment.

"It looks like we've entered a movie."

"I don't think there's any safety measures in here. Can I survive if I jump the moment I fall?"

"You're still joking, so I guess you're really okay."

"I like movies."

[Approaching the upper scenario area!]

Then, the pressure of the upper scenario began to press upon us.

Constellations twinkled in the distance. Their starlight, at first glance, was unfriendly. All that could protect us from this terrifying threat was an old joke.

"Then you might hate it from now on."

And then, from somewhere, a story's voice came.

「At the end of the world, the twilight of the stars finally begins.」

The mere hearing of the immense story's awe-inspiring power was dizzying. The final chapter of the Great Destruction scenario, where even Mythical Constellations couldn't guarantee life or death.

「All the stories of the universe will hold their breath before eternal life.」

'Ragnarok' awaited us.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 958 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (1)

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「"Isn't it fascinating that, from the universe's perspective, something as simple as the twinkling of a single star can determine the day and night of a world? From my perspective, destruction is the same thing."」

—The Wenny King

---

Ragnarok, the twilight of the gods, was one of the representative 'giant stories' of the Star Stream, along with Olympus's 'Gigantomachia', Emperor's 'Journey to the West', and Eden's 'Great War of Good and Evil'.

Nevertheless, Ragnarok was never described in detail in the main story, in fact, because it was excluded from the scenario strategy route chosen by Kim Dokja.

「If a 'Ragnarok' of the Great Destruction were to occur, the Star Stream would have entered the process of complete annihilation.」

What would the original 41st round have been like? Did Yoo Joonghyuk experience Ragnarok? Or did he die before? Or if not—

"Dokja-ssi."

Jung Heewon's voice brought me to my senses. The universe was rippling like waves, starlight shining down on me. The Orbital Elevator swayed precariously, as if it might explode at any moment.

[Oh, no.]

At the same time, the Wenny King's words rang in my ears.

[We've been discovered. Be careful.]

I cursed inwardly.

That's right. There's no way that Wenny King could safely take us to the 'higher scenario'.

[Even I can't avoid the gaze of every Constellation. Especially not in this 'scenario'.]

I wondered what he was talking about, but I didn't have time to think about it in detail.

[The Constellation, 'Goddess of Love and Cats', bewares of you!]

[The Constellation, 'One Who Lost His Words to the Wolf of Destruction', roars at you!]

[The Constellation, 'Thursday Thunder', unleashes divine punishment on the wicked forces of Hell!]

I don't know why, but it seemed like there had been a misunderstanding.

No. Maybe it wasn't a misunderstanding. After all, things haven't been so good with the <Asgard> since the 'Star Ladder' incident.

"Hold on tight, Heewon-ssi."

I held my breath, staring at the lightning bolts flying toward the 'Orbital Elevator'.

In any case, the scenario area would be reached in a single breath.

The moment Thor's lightning struck the Orbital Elevator, I manifested the power of the 'Demon King of Salvation'. [Way of the Wind] was imbued in my outstretched wings.

I grabbed Jung Heewon's wrist and launched myself upward. As the Constellations' quest for me rapidly retreated, I felt a rippling void curtain brush past us.

[Entering the upper scenario area!]

A system message echoed in my head. I slowly closed my eyes, the weight of the 'Giant Story' weighing down my voice. I looked around and saw Jung Heewon lightly releasing her hand.

"This is an unexpected turn of events. I knew you'd start fighting right away."

Jung Heewon must have felt the story's pressure grow even stronger, but her expression remained composed. She must have been delighted that Jung Heewon had grown enough to withstand the story's thunderous, higher scenario.

"You shouldn't let your guard down."

"That's right. But where is this place?"

I looked around with Jung Heewon. We had landed on a somewhat desolate entrance. After walking a short distance along the entrance, a small holographic sign appeared.

[The 'ticket booth' is ahead.]

Ticket booth. Jung Heewon glared at it for a moment, as if grasping the hidden meaning of the word, and then asked,

"Are they selling tickets?"

"I suppose so."

"A 'Ragnarok' scenario, huh? Selling tickets when the world is on the brink of destruction?"

"The Constellations enjoy even their longing as a story."

They revel in the stories of the incarnations, and even their own demise is a show.

It's likely they were so obsessed with stories that they burned everything they had to become Constellations.

"Let's go."

Since we'd passed through the void veil, there had been no sign of the Constellations approaching, so we proceeded along the access road at a leisurely pace.

Footprints, large and small, were imprinted throughout the access road. Some appeared human, others like those of giants or benevolent beings.

「Accumulation leading to longing.」

I recalled the mention of this access road in 'Ways of Survival'.

「Everyone, at their own pace, participated in the naming. To be the last of this world, to be recognized.」

I walked among the jumbled mass of footprints, searching for those I recognized. The footprints of those who had walked this path before me. Suddenly, I could hear the voices of my companions, looming over the two hundred feet between those footprints.

「"Friend."」

Those footsteps, slightly gloomy yet resolute, seemed to belong to Dansu ahjussi.

「"Kim Dokja will be me."」

The confident and strangely arrogant footsteps seemed to belong to Ye Hyunwoo.

「"Author-nim."」

The footsteps, with their precise strides, seemed to belong to Ji Eunyu.

「"I'll go first."」

Some of the footsteps, hesitating and turning back every now and then, seemed to belong to Cha Yerin.

Of course, all these thoughts could just be my delusions. The group might have already forgotten me. Eight years may have changed them, and 'Kim Dokja' might already have a different meaning for them.

Nevertheless.

「All these records were just my one-sided effort to remember them.」

I looked back and saw the footprints of me and Jung Heewon. Although they were clearly ours, they were also imprinted with the footprints of others, not just ours.

「"I'm Kyung Sein."」

Kyung Sein.

「"I don't know why, but I've always been a little lucky..."」

Jung Jaewoo.

「"Just go back to that point. There's nothing to be afraid of."」

Goo Seonah.

I walked, and walked again, engraving the names of the readers I'd met. How far had I walked?

「"I'll wait, Kim Dokja."」

When we finally stood before the tactile marker that seemed to belong to Killer King, a building reminiscent of the Colosseum stood before us.

It was strange. A building this massive should have been visible from afar. Perhaps there was some special story concealing the building itself.

[Ticket booth.]

There was a short line in front of the ticket booth. There were about five or six customers waiting. It seemed like I had to buy a ticket here to enter 'Ragnarok'.

"Why am I of this rank!? What criteria—"

Judging by the slight scuffle in the front row, it was going to take some time.

Jung Heewon, somewhat relaxed, let out a dejected voice.

"It's like entering an amusement park."

"You know how scary movies that start like that are."

"Stop scaring me."

Seeing that we could chat like this over a doomsday scenario made me think we weren't in our right minds. Anyway, as we waited in line, exchanging light banter, a man standing in a corner of the ticket booth caught my eye.

Wrapped in a thick black cape, he looked around suspiciously.

I averted my gaze, feeling it wouldn't be good to get involved, but sure enough, the man spotted us and approached us.

"Are you guys planning to enter the battlefield?"

His voice was gravelly, as if he'd smoked several packs of cigarettes a day.

I briefly met Jung Heewon's eyes and nodded slightly, and the man smirked, as if he'd expected me to. He smiled.

"You look like newcomers. You don't have to get tickets at the ticket booth. I just happen to have tickets for two people."

I replied, looking at the man's blackened front teeth.

"We'll just buy them at the ticket booth."

"It'll be expensive, right?"

"It's okay. I have some coins."

"It's not just the price. You know what happens if you enter through the official route, don't you? If you're unlucky enough to get a wrong grade and end up in a strange place..."

The man stopped talking and glanced at me, then beamed.

"You guys. You came all this way without knowing anything, huh?"

"In any case, I have no intention of buying tickets on the black market."

"Don't worry about the price. I'll give you the tickets for free."

"Free?"

Jung Heewon beamed, and the man nodded vigorously, holding out two tickets from his pocket.

"Yes. Even if I'm a merchant, I can't charge you the same price as someone who is new here. Here."

I stared down at the ticket the man offered me and said,

"No, I won't take it."

"What? Why?"

"We want to enter with dignity."

The man's expression changed at my answer.

"You know what this ticket is, don't you?"

For a moment, I felt ominous. The man took a step closer and asked,

"Shouldn't you be entering through that 'ticket booth'?"

The air in the area slowly shifted. The man's distorted expression darkened, and his lips moved. It was [Transmission].

—I can sense it. You have a contract with an Outer God, right? Who? Who did you contact? ■■■■? Or ■■■■■■■? The man with the forked tongue took a step closer to me.

Jung Heewon, her expression hardened, placed her hand on the hilt of her sword.

—You must come here. The army of hell awaits you.

I stopped her and asked the man,

"What are you talking about?"

"Are you planning to pretend you don't know?"

The man glared at me with frustration, then spat out.

"Think carefully. You don't have to side with the Constellations and see the world's ■■. Don't you know? How insignificant the ideals of those cowardly Constellations are. What meaning does the end of everything hold for this universe?"

The man, having spoken passionately, took another step closer. He then held my wrist with one hand, trying to hand me the ticket.

"Hurry up and win. This battlefield needs you. A talent like yours, I'll have to write a letter of recommendation myself, even if it means—"

At that moment, something strange happened. The hand that had grabbed my wrist began to turn a bright red.

The man, who had hurriedly grabbed my wrist as if burned by a hot fire, screamed. The ticket he'd dropped fluttered and fell to the floor.

The man, who had been staring blankly down at his hand, suddenly raised his head and looked up at me.

"See…"

I felt something stirring inside me.

[The story, 'King of Fear', shows signs of discomfort.]

The pale man suddenly fell to the floor and muttered.

"See you."

"What…"

"Oh great master. Oh King of Fear. The final coordinates of the distant Apocalypse Record..."

"Excuse me."

"Ugh, ugh. Ugh—!"

As I approached, the man who had started the fight trembled and began to run away in a hurry.

As the sound barrier he had deployed disappeared, the noise of the area returned to my ears.

Jung Heewon asked, dumbfounded.

"What just happened? Do you know the way?"

"It seems similar."

I gave Jung Heewon a vague explanation, but I knew which group the man who had spoken to us was a member of.

「The Seeker of the End.」

The man who had just disappeared was a member of the 'Seeker of the End', the core force behind this grand narrative, 'Ragnarok'.

I looked down at the two tickets that had fallen to the floor and tried to pick them up.

Jung Heewon asked,

"Are you going to use them?"

In the meantime, the line had thinned considerably, and it was soon our turn.

Somehow, the very beginning of this grand narrative scenario felt unusual.

Pay the fair entrance fee to enter the battlefield, or use the black market ticket you happened to get?

「What choice would Kim Dokja make?」

I slowly opened my mouth.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 959 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (2)

"No. I won't use it."

What choice would Kim Dokja have made? A true Kim Dokja wouldn't think like that.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', finds your thoughts amusing.]

In the past, I would have laughed at my thoughts, but now I felt no particular emotion.

「A Kim Dokja who isn't Kim Dokja can still be Kim Dokja.」

After meeting and parting ways with so many readers, I may have come to terms with that fact to some extent.

Jung Heewon observed me blankly and then asked,

"If you weren't going to use it, why did you pick it up?"

"The more options, the better."

I answered, looking down at the ticket the ticket seller had given me.

The ticket seller was probably surprised to see me because he sensed the story of the 'King of Fear' within me.

Jung Heewon, who was examining the ticket with me, asked.

"Just looking at it, it doesn't seem like an ordinary ticket."

"That's right. This ticket isn't a 'regular admission ticket'."

"What do you mean?"

I briefly explained to Jung Heewon what I knew about 'Ragnarok'.

According to 'Ways of Survival', the apocalyptic battlefield of 'Ragnarok' unfolds into two major factions.

「One is the power of the Constellations, including Asgard.」

The first faction, naturally, was the Constellations of Asgard, which held the source of the giant story.

In reality, most Constellations—especially those or incarnations of the 'absolute good' lineage—often chose this faction and participated in the battle.

Of course, not all Constellations chose this side.

「The forces of disaster and hell, dreaming of the world's end.」

Some Constellations of absolute evil, beasts, or even slightly deranged demon kings sometimes chose the latter. The 'Apocalypse Seekers' who had handed me the tickets were of the same type.

"These tickets are an invitation to the second power."

"It's a horse in the middle of disaster."

I could vaguely guess why the ticket scalper had approached us.

Jung Heewon and I had come here under the protection of the 'Wenny King', and in the process, they must have sensed the power of the Outer Gods.

The 'Apocalypse Seekers', who react to otherworldly powers, must have sensed the nuances of the Outer Gods in us.

"Should I just use those tickets? Stand on the side of disaster and kill all the Constellations."

"If disaster wins, the world will yearn for it."

"Isn't that what you came for?"

I wondered if Jung Heewon knew how much comfort this brief flirtation brought me.

While standing with Jung Herwon and discussing which Constellation to start with, it was already our turn.

The ticket booth employee, upon spotting us, smiled meaningfully and asked, "You won't use that 'ticket'?"

I shrugged as the employee pushed up his glasses with his index finger.

"Yes. I won't."

"A pig?"

"Just that."

When I tried to brush it off, the employee narrowed his eyes and said,

"The recipients of that ticket are determined. They are either under the protection of a Constellation of 'absolute evil' or are incarnations of fallen Constellations. In rare cases, they are tainted by otherworldly stories..."

The employee's eyes glowed bright, as if he could identify me. But it wouldn't be easy. I'd completely suppressed the stories of the 'King of Fear'.

The employee, who had been staring at me with a disapproving expression, turned to Jung Heewon and concluded.

"And those who harbor a deep grudge against the Constellations also receive the invitation."

"Well, it applies to a variety of reasons."

"With that ticket, you can become a member of the Hell Army. Without going through the unreasonable rank-based system, you'll be sent straight to the battlefield of 'Ragnarok'. If even the ticket scalpers were offering free tickets, you'll probably—"

"Aren't you going to sell your tickets?"

"We've finally got some talented people here."

The ticket booth employee's eyes flickered with surprise as he saw us.

[Someone is activating 'Cold Observation'.]

「Cold Observation is a skill that allows you to estimate the combined stamina, agility, and strength of an opponent, regardless of whether they possess a 'Mental Barrier'.」

The employee's expression brightened considerably, as if he was quite pleased with my and Jung Heewon's stats.

"One of them seems to be a Transcendent. You're an Incarnation? Or a Constellation?"

"Which do you think it is?"

The employee looked confused. It made sense. Since I'd reached myth-grade, my control of my rank had become even more refined. Now, unless it was a Constellation sensitive to stories, it wouldn't be easy to gauge my rank.

"If you're going to keep messing around, I won't be giving you ticket."

"I'm not a Constellation."

While I was acknowledged as a Myth-grade, strictly speaking, I wasn't a Constellation.

[Someone is activating 'Lie Detection'!]

['Lie Detection' has confirmed the truth of your words.]

I saw the employee nod.

I thought that's what he'd be using.

"You seem to have entered through ascension. Who recommended you? Which company do you work for?"

"I didn't receive a separate recommendation."

When I answered that, the employee's gaze grew even more strange.

"Do you have a sponsor?"

"No."

"There's no sponsor?"

The employee pondered my words, then began scribbling something in the air.

"The entrance fee is 5,000 coins."

It was cheaper than I expected.

After paying the coins, a message flashed before my eyes.

[Your evaluation rank is 'Mid-Low Warrior'.]

I paused for a moment, staring down at the ranking chart.

Mid-Low Warrior? Me?

I, who had reached the equivalent of a 'Mythical Constellation', am a 'Mid-Low Warrior'?

No, does that mean all those above me are mythical?

As if sensing my doubt, the employee added apologetically,

"You should have been given a higher rank, but unfortunately, the 'sponsor' bonus points are important in this 'ranking process'."

"Isn't it better without a sponsor?"

"Would a normal incarnation have made it this far without a sponsor?"

Well, that was true.

Only a lunatic like Kim Dokja could make it to the final scenario without a sponsor.

['Scenario 85' is currently in progress in that area.]

The Colosseum before us is, in fact, 'Scenario 85'. If any incarnation has made it this far without a sponsor, it's either one of two things:

A fraud. Or a truly insane person.

Jung Heewon, who was watching the conversation from the side, asked,

"Is there a disadvantage to receiving a low rank?"

"Disadvantage, so to speak. It might be a bit of a hassle. Let's see, you..."

After saying that, the employee began observing Jung Heewon.

"Do you have a sponsor?"

"No."

"I see."

"How much should I pay?"

"One thousand coins."

One thousand coins? No, you took five thousand from me, didn't you?

Before I could even file a claim, the employee scribbled something in the air and handed me Jung Heewon's rank chart. After examining the chart, I feigned envy and looked at Jung Heewon.

"Heewon-ssi, tell me the truth. Who is the person you've been secretly hiding behind?"

"If there was, would I have suffered all this?"

Jung Heewon's rank evaluation was as follows:

「Special-rank warrior.」

It was strange. There's no sponsor, yet I'm mid-level and Jung Heewon is special-rank?

"The Transcendent is an exception. There's a special order to treat them favorably."

An order to treat the transcendents favorably. The Constellations, who despise mortals, suddenly issued such an order?

"It's been a while since I've seen a Transcendent this well-trained. If you wish, I can connect you with the highest-ranking deities of Asgard right away. Someone as talented as you could become an Einherjar, a commander on the Great Field."

"What's an Einherjar?"

"That's... well, it's a good one. It's a position everyone inside desires."

"No. I want to achieve everything with my own strength."

The employee nodded, as if he'd expected that.

"So all human transcendents are like this. Okay, I get it."

Surprisingly, the employee readily let Jung Heewon go.

Honestly, I couldn't understand this. If she had truly been a talented individual, he should have worked harder to recruit her, but the employee's resignation and discouragement were too swift.

Jung Heewon, who had been studying her own rank chart for a while, turned to me and asked,

"How good would a special rank be?"

"It'd be just below top rank."

"It feels strange. I never received a rank like that in school."

Jung Heewon, who had been sneaking a glance at my rank chart, asked in a much quieter voice,

"Should I change it with you?"

"He's watching."

"Then I'll secretly change it with you when I get back in. I'm feeling the pressure of this rank."

"That guy's staring at us."

"But class assignments don't change based on rank, do they?"

"I don't know about that either."

"Does the war start as soon as you enter?"

The employee, who had been listening to our conversation, looked dumbfounded, then chuckled.

"War? You guys really don't know what 'Ragnarok' is."

"You don't have to go in and start a war, do you?"

"If something like that really starts, everyone dies. Well, even if it doesn't start, the unlucky ones will die anyway."

Before I could even ask what he meant, the employee's eyes began to swirl.

"It's almost time for the 'next battlefield' to open. You might even receive a summons offer. Please choose carefully. Even if you die in the first battle, if you performed well, you'll have a chance to be resurrected..."

[You have been granted entry into 'Scenario 85'.]

[Would you like to enter this scenario?]

As we nodded, the swirling eyes of the staff began to draw us in.

"Not everyone can be 'resurrected'. May the blessings of the story be with you all."

As the incarnation body was sucked into the employee's eye, the sound of crows cawing could be heard from somewhere. Two giant ravens danced in circles directly above my head.

I immediately recognized them.

「The ravens of Lord Odin.」

Hugin and Munin. They were the servants of Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father'.

The circle the ravens drew soon took the shape of a giant eye.

「Every time the master of dreams blinks, the birth and death of the universe accompany him.」

An eye that watched over everything on earth.

The moment my gaze met that eye, I felt an inexplicable elation.

「Only those who receive the gaze will become the new lords of power.」

I felt as if all the starlight in the universe was illuminating me. My incarnation's senses opened simultaneously.

When I blinked, feeling it, I was inside the Colosseum.

Ohhhhhhh—!

Deafening cheers. Majestic mantras erupted from all sides.

Amidst the immense ripples of power emitted by the gathered Constellations, the story within me stirred.

After taking several deep breaths, I slowly blinked, and the surrounding scenery came into view.

I was sitting in the audience with Jung Heewon.

Ohhhhhhh—!

Constellations bursting upward one after another.

I saw Constellations filling the audience. From the Historic-grade Constellations to the late Narrative-grade Constellations, or even beyond. It was my first time seeing so many Constellations gathered in one place. The mere presence of them created a scene of immense probability.

[Go! Fight! Kill them all!]

[Kuhahahahahaha!]

The Constellations that let out hearty laughter were clearly the Constellations I remembered.

However, the strange thing was that their expressions conveyed a subtle sense of resignation and frustration.

Among them, there were some Constellations I recognized.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', anxiously wipes his head!]

Had the story been damaged? The Bald General was staring off into space, wiping fragments of stories from his head.

[The match is currently in progress.]

I turned my gaze, wondering what he was looking at, and saw a giant screen installed in the center of the Colosseum. Beneath the screen was a vast map, and on it, like miniature figures, were running around.

[A new main scenario has arrived!]

[You have entered the halls of the great 'Valhalla'.]

[You can select a battlefield within the hall.]

[The 1263rd battlefield is currently in progress.]

On the screen, Constellations and incarnations were slaughtering each other. They ripped out each other's hearts and beheaded each other without hesitation.

A phrase from 'Ways of Survival' naturally came to mind.

I see. Perhaps this scene of 'Valhalla' I'm seeing now is...

「Ragnarok, 999th round.」

'Ragnarok' had slightly different developments in each of Yoo Joonghyuk's rounds.

Unlike other rounds where the main battlefield opened immediately, the 999th round of 'Ragnarok' had a unique filter.

「Those who entered 'Ragnarok' through the ticket booth in the 999th round will enter the 'Battlefield' of the Preliminary Battle via Valhalla.」

This was the Preliminary Battle system.

「Only those who win the 'Battlefield' of the Preliminary Battle will become great 'Einherar' and advance to the higher battlefields.」

In essence, only those who won this Preliminary Battle would have the chance to enter the true 'Ragnarok'.

Perhaps confused by the situation, Jung Heewon asked.

"Why are they fighting when they are on the same side?"

"It's probably a Preliminary Battle to select elite soldiers."

"Really? We'll be going to the battlefield anyway, so why hold such an event?"

Jung Heewon was right. We'll all be fighting on the same side once we advance to the higher battlefields anyway, so why bother holding something like a Preliminary Battle to

select elite soldiers?

「"War? You guys really don't know what 'Ragnarok' is."」

Recalling the employee's words that suddenly came to mind, we watched the match on screen.

The match consisted of two groups fighting on a small battlefield.

The battlefield layout... Wait, where have I seen that before?

Jung Heewon seemed to have a similar thought, saying to me,

"That seems a bit like a game."

"Yes. That seems right."

If my guess is correct, the skirmish battlefield was similar to the main scenario in the main story, where Kim Dokja participated in the 'Demon King Selection Tournament'.

「Mythical Battlefield.」

The game was won by acquiring all of the specific 'emblems' on the battlefield or by killing all the participants in the opposing group.

I haven't checked the detailed description yet, but this battlefield also seemed to be composed of similar water.

—Damage! Aaaah!

—Save me! Save me! If I die this time, it's over!

Blue and red dots were displayed on the map. Judging by the rapid decrease in red dots, the blue team seemed to have an overwhelming advantage.

[As expected, he's the third son of Bishamonten!]

[The owner of the Three Blue Spears!]

Judging by the cheering, the team wearing blue seemed to be the Constellations of the <Emperor>.

If Bishamonten's third son is 'Natha', then the owner of the Three Blue Spears would be 'Irang Jingun'.

Both are legendary. As the <Emperor>'s main force, who had recently ascended, it was only natural that their mediocre skills would be no match for them.

It seemed as if the red team, in crisis, would be the first to come forward, but the outcome of the match was decided in an instant.

[Team 'Fengshen Yanyi' won the 1263rd battlefield.]

The victorious blue team was seen advancing to the next battlefield amidst cheers. Meanwhile, the incarnations of the losing team were saying, "Huh? I guess we're not dead."

Surprisingly, the incarnations who had been beheaded or had their hearts ripped out in the competition were alive and well. However, their pale, ashen faces didn't quite resemble those of the living.

[All members of the defeated faction are summoned.]

A total of twelve members were summoned to the throne.

[The 'Execution Ceremony' begins.]

Then, the incarnations' bodies were tied in mid-air, and a giant guillotine appeared above their necks.

The Constellations snickered from all around, as if they were enjoying the sight.

[Hmm, whose fate is it this time?]

[What do you think? This time too...]

[Well, it's already decided.]

A message from the stadium came up along with the voice of the Constellation.

[The 'Execution Voting' begins.]

[All Emperors can choose a 'wealthy person' of the party by assigning a position in the sarang.]

[Those selected as 'resurrected ones' will be excluded from the 'Execution' and will be re-elected. They can participate in the preliminary battle once.]

[Listen carefully to the final messages from the participants and vote.]

The faces of the losing team's participants zoomed in on the screen, one by one.

"S-save me! Please save me! I can do better! There's so much I haven't shown you yet!"

The incarnations, facing death, were crying out. They begged for their lives, that they could do better next time. They didn't want to die. Watching them repeat the same words with different faces, I recalled the staff member's words.

「"Even if you die in the first battle, if you performed exceptionally well, you'll have a chance to be resurrected..."」

I wondered if that was what he meant.

"That bastard! We lost because of him! He deserved to die!"

"It was because of you! Damn it! Save me! Please!"

The Constellations' laughter grew even louder as they exchanged insults on the scaffold. Jung Heewon groaned, clearly displeased with the situation. As each person's will flowed, the final incarnation finally arrived. It was the incarnation that appeared to be the commander of the Red Team.

"Please."

Bright blonde hair rippled across the screen.

I stared blankly at the commander, her face bloodied.

"Please save them."

She was an incarnation I knew well. Perhaps as ambitious as Yoo Joonghyuk. However, her inflexibility and lack of eloquence made her enemies easily.

"Save others, not me."

At the end of this world, a person who dreamed of a 'Perfect Night' where all the Constellations had vanished.

She, who had been like that, was begging to the Constellations.

"I now—"

My colleague, who wasn't Korean but had a Korean name. I remembered her name for the first time in a while.

"I don't want to continue this damned game."

Kim Anna-ssi.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 960 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (3)

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Eight years ago, immediately after escaping from the Fear Realm, Anna Croft and the Transcendents took refuge on the 'Isle of Reincarnators'.

[Prophet of Asgard.]

The great King of Reincarnators. The master of the 'Isle of Reincarnators', Sakyamuni, offered her protection from the Nebulae, but with one condition.

[In exchange for staying on the island, you and the Transcendents will be required to perform a small service on the island.]

"Service..."

[It's nothing special. Maybe just helping with chores on the island.]

"How long can we stay?"

[Five years.]

Five years. That was the time promised to the Prophet Anna Croft by the King of Reincarnators. In some ways, it was a long time, but in others, it was also a short time.

Now, there was no Fear Realm to protect her, and the King of Fear was gone. And outside, the Constellations of <Asgard> were targeting her.

"Why five years? Not more?"

[Because you have a predetermined 'Fate'. The island cannot defy providence.]

Fate. Anna Croft bit her lip and asked again.

"I heard there are recorders who can change [Fate]."

[The 'Fate' that resides within you cannot be easily modified.]

Anna knew this.

The [Fate] given to her was formed through a contract.

No recorder can easily tamper with a [Fate] bound by a sacred contract.

"Can you see my future?"

[Don’t you already know?]

Anna nodded.

Her core ability was [Future Sight].

At some point, predicting the exact future became difficult, but she remained closer to the 'future' than anyone else. She knew her own future. She simply wanted to receive confirmation from Shakyamuni.

[Five years later, the 'God of Mischief' will seek you out.]

The God of Mischief. Anna Croft knew who he was. He wielded otherworldly power and opposed the 'Management Bureau'. He was also the Constellation of Asgard who had sponsored her with the 'Eye of the Great Demon'.

[Some times pass quickly, some slowly. Use the five years given to you wisely.]

After five years on the island, Anna Croft was banished. And as if by promise, the Constellations awaited her outside the island.

[I've come to get you, Prophet.]

They were the Constellations of Asgard.

"You too are sick of this."

Because she already knew the future, Anna Croft wasn't flustered. She didn't even think about resisting. Even she couldn't face a dozen Constellations, including a Constellations of the highest order, alone.

And above all else…

[You betrayed Asgard and aided a threat designated by the Nebula.]

She had a reason to be captured here.

[As the representative incarnation of Asgard, you must know the gravity of your sins.]

"You say you're the representative incarnation, but what have you done to me?"

She protested, but the Asgard Constellations paid no attention.

In an instant, the Constellations subdued her, bound her hands and feet with story metal, and spoke.

[Should she have been sentenced to 500 years of slavery in Muspelheim?]

The one who came to fetch her, representing the alabaster Constellations, was a a constellation following Heimdall, the Guardian of the Great Horn Bridge.

[The great 'One-Eyed Father' has specially entrusted you with a mission.]

Bard, the 'Guardian of the Boundary'. He brandished a massive spear made of stag antler and announced Anna Croft's fate.

[Participate in the preliminary battle of 'Ragnarok'. Then we will forgive you for betraying the Nebula.]

---

Anna Croft opened her eyes with a start, feeling a surge of relief. Her head was spinning, and she kept feeling nauseous.

'Again.'

Holding her grip on the dirt, she managed to regain her balance and stood up, her surrounding battlefield in full view.

[The 'Preliminary Battle' will begin soon!]

[The 1265th battlefield opens!]

Looking at the desolate landscape of the grassland, Anna Croft thought about Yoo Joonghyuk.

Perhaps the Supreme King felt this way.

The first, second, third, fourth... Even the Supreme King, who had repeated dozens of such regressions, must have welcomed each new world with this same feeling.

[The majority of Constellations have approved your resurrection.]

[You have been designated as the 'Resurrected One'.]

Unknown. All she knew for sure was that this damned game would repeat itself again.

[You were automatically summoned to this battlefield by your contract with <Asgard>.]

Anna Croft was confident when she first arrived. She hadn't been idle for the past five years, after all.

[You have entered the main scenario area.]

[Main Scenario #85 — The rules for the 'Outpost' are revealed.]

She had obtained information about 'Ragnarok' through her deal with the Buddha, thoroughly analyzed it, and trained accordingly.

「Only those who have obtained the final prophecy at the twilight of the gods will be able to stand on the battlefield of 'Vigrid'.」

The stage for advancing to 'Vigrid', the main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'.

The rules for this 'Outpost' were simple.

* The victory conditions for the 'Outpost' are as follows:

1. A Skirmish involves as few as two teams and as many as eight teams, depending on the size of the battlefield.

2. The team that collects all the 'Prophecies' scattered across the battlefield wins.

3. The team that kills all enemy units on the battlefield wins.

Either collecting all the 'Prophecies' scattered across the battlefield or killing all enemy units.

A Skirmish could be won by meeting either of these two conditions.

The problem was the additional rules required to meet these conditions.

* Additional rules for 'Skirmish' are as follows:

1. Each 'Skirmish' team consists of 'twelve' members.

2. The twelve team members are randomly selected (though they may also be recommended if supported by a Constellation).

3. If there are not enough members, each team's commander can use the 'Summon Cost' to select additional team members.

…

Even though it was information she knew well, Anna Croft read the same sentence over and over again, wondering if there might be some rule she hadn't read.

Of course, there was no such rule. Nevertheless, she read the sentence over and over again, hoping to delay the tragedy that was destined for her, even if only a little.

「She remembered her first battlefield.」

She had confidently entered the first battlefield. She had been sufficiently prepared. However, there was one unexpected variable—her [Future Sight] wouldn't work on this 'battlefield'.

「"Anna! What should we do now?"」

She couldn't figure out why. Perhaps the battlefield had been designed specifically to block her [Future Sight], or perhaps it was a plot by <Asgard>.

「"Save me... Please save me!"」

She couldn't simply lament the fact that her [Future Sight] had been blocked. No matter the situation, all she could do was give it her all. She fought with all her might, and narrowly lost. One silver lining was that defeat didn't mean the scenario was over.

5. All members of the defeated team will be placed on the ‘execution platform'.

6. The incarnations on the platform will be executed after the 'final speech'.

7. Only one incarnation chosen by the Constellations on the platform can become the 'Resurrected One'.

The resurrection system was the true charm of this 'preliminary battle'. Even if the team's luck was poor, if 'she did well', she could still get another chance.

「"Choose me."」

Atop the execution platform, Anna confidently addressed the Constellations.

「"I did my best. Give me one more chance. I can show you an even more magnificent performance."」

Given the stunned looks of her fellow participants, Anna believed this was the right thing to do for the greater good of this world. The Constellations granted her request.

[You have been designated as the 'Resurrected One'.]

And so the next battle began.

This time, having tried once, she thought she could do better. Still unable to see the future, she fought with all her might.

This time, the result was a disappointing defeat.

「"Please save me."」

Anna Croft pleaded once more. The Constellations granted her request once again.

「"Please save me."」

Then, similar events repeated themselves. She fought with all her might, lost, and begged the gods.

「"So, me."」

Please save her, please give her one more chance.

「"Next time, really—"」

Ten times, then twenty.

Anna Croft began to realize something was amiss.

「"Anna?"」

When did it begin? One by one, those close to her began to be summoned. They were the remnants of Zarathustra, whom she had never believed were still alive.

「"Jade?"」

「"Oh, Anna! We finally met!"」

She lost Jade in the 589th battle.

「"Marin."」

「"I'm glad I could be with you."」

She lost Marin in the 874th battle. It was the same in the 911th battle, and in the 934th battle.

One day, as she watched and watched those familiar faces disappear one by one,

「"I."」

She stood before the Constellations.

「"I'm sorry. I can't do well."」

For the first time, she let herself go.

「"I'm not as great as you think I am. I don't deserve to be resurrected."」

The Constellations laughed. A long caw of a crow was heard from somewhere, followed by a mantra.

「"Child, do you think we saved you because you're so great?"」

The executioner's blade fell, and her comrades' heads were cut off.

The battlefield opened once more. She was defeated again. She lost her comrades.

And then she realized.

「"She was never meant to win this 'battlefield' from the start."」

The match, which seemed to have been lost by a narrow margin, was in fact rigged to suit the Constellations' preferences.

[The majority of Constellations rejoice in your defeat.]

An overwhelming number of Constellations cheered her enemy. Faced with the increasing odds and the shrinking 'Summon Cost', her team was annihilated every time.

Anna Croft felt something inside her crumble. No matter what she did, she couldn't win.

A battle. All her summoned allies died, and she was constantly resurrected.

[You are currently a 'Commander'.]

And she stood on the battlefield once more.

[The summoning cost you have been given is 100D.]

[Constellations supporting each team can invest their probability to increase the team's 'Summoning Cost'.]

Listening to the system messages that followed, Anna slowly sank to her knees.

At one point, she even hoped for a miracle. Perhaps an incarnation as powerful as the Supreme King would be summoned to her team.

But that never happened, and the incarnations she trusted in all but one died without exception.

From that moment on, she had only one wish:

「That no one she knows be summoned to this battlefield.」

In a dazzling beam of light, the random summoning began.

[Your team members have been randomly summoned.]

Anna Croft studied their faces anxiously, as if opening a deck of cards. Most of them were unfamiliar faces.

That was until she turned over the last card.

"Anna."

As if a tragedy had been destined, a familiar face was there. A woman waved at her with a warm smile she'd long remembered.

"You... You are really here."

Anna Croft called her name in despair.

"Selena Kim."

Selena Kim. One of the original members of 'Zarathustra'. Ultimately, she, too, had been dragged into this battlefield.

[Many constellations rejoice, anticipating your tragedy.]

This 'Random Summoning' was, in name only, a random summoning, but it could have been recommended by the Constellations.

So, this too must have been the work of the Constellations.

Anna Croft calmly assessed the situation and began speaking to Selena Kim.

"Selena, request the Constellations of <Asgard>. We must escape from here immediately."

There was no way to save Selena Kim.

"They must have another ticket to the 'main battlefield'. You must escape, even if it means making a dirty deal. You alone—"

"Anna."

Listening to Selena Kim, who shook her head silently, Anna Croft belatedly realized what was going on.

"You volunteered? Is that true?"

"Yes."

"Why did you do that?"

"I heard what you've been through here."

Surely, it wouldn't be surprising for Selena Kim to do something so reckless.

Anna Croft let out a deep sigh and shouted reproachfully.

"Did you even know where this was?"

"Anna, don't give up. You can overcome this."

"You don't know anything."

Anna Croft looked at the randomly summoned incarnations. At first glance, they looked like a ragtag bunch.

"Really, you don't know anything."

They were the terminal incarnations of each Nebula, then abandoned.

[Your team currently has ten members.]

[You can summon additional allies to aid you in battle using the 'Summon Cost'.]

Selena Kim spoke again, seemingly aware of her intentions.

"I know you can't use [Future Sight]. But not knowing the future isn't necessarily a disadvantage. You never know. Just as I came here, there might be other allies we don't know about—"

As soon as those words left her mouth, a message rang out from the air.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', claims to be your ally.]

Selena Kim's expression brightened.

"See? I told you! If it's him—"

"Bald General of Justice."

Anna Croft cut Selena Kim off, looking up into the air.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', looks at you.]

"I can't accept your help."

"What—"

"If you lose again, you will be annihilated."

Only after hearing those words did Selena Kim seem to realize what was going on.

"No way."

Anna Croft nodded.

"That Constellation has already used probability to help me several times."

She didn't understand why that Constellation on the Korean Peninsula, with whom she had no connection, had gone to such lengths to help her.

However, Anna Croft was grateful to the Constellation, and that was why she couldn't rely on his help any longer.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is furious and confident she can win this time.]

"I appreciate your kind words, but I don't have enough 'Summon Cost' left to summon you anyway."

Bald General of Justice (Mid-Rank Warrior)

—The strongest tank on the Korean Peninsula!

—Summon Cost 250D

Bald General of Justice's minimum summon cost was 250D.

However, the summon cost given to her was only 100D.

['Summon Helper' will end soon.]

Just then, the enemy team's helper summoning seemed to be coming to an end.

[The Constellation, 'Thunder-Eater', prepares for battle!]

The enemy team's main helpers were the Constellations of <Vedas>. Among them, the most crucial was the Narrative-grade Constellation 'Thunder-Eating Bird'. Even at the lowest level, he was a warrior approaching 'high-level' status.

"Anna, we don't have time."

There were no two resurrected in a single match. If she lost this match again, she would lose Selena Kim.

"Yes."

Taking deep breaths, Anna Croft thought about Yoo Joonghyuk.

What would Yoo Joonghyuk do in a situation like this?

No, not Yoo Joonghyuk—

「What would 'he' do?」

Memories of the man's subtle narrowing eyes forced Anna Croft to smile bitterly. Even though she knew it was a futile thought, Anna Croft often found herself lost in thought about him.

Standing before a blank space, unwritten by past or future, he was unafraid to fulfill the role assigned to him.

"Let's find... an assistant."

[Use the 'Summoning Scroll'.]

[Check the list of warriors on standby.]

Anna Croft controlled her breathing and unfolded the 'Summoning Scroll'.

The warriors she could summon with the current 'Summoning Cost' were at best 'mid-level'.

Still, she was in no position to be picky. Even then, it was only when the opponent complied.

[The target refused the summoning.]

[The target refused the summoning.]

As expected. Anna bit her lip as she listened to the repeated summoning rejection messages.

At that moment, Selena Kim, who had been examining the summoning scroll with her, spoke.

"Anna. What about this warrior? The introduction is a bit strange, though…"

Anna Croft looked to where Selena Kim had spoken. At the end of the scroll. A single line of introduction was written on the border between a mid-level warrior and a low-level warrior.

> —Myth-grade Constellation hiding its power.

It was a foolish introduction. A Myth-grade Constellation couldn't possibly be on the list of 'mid-level warriors'.

Still, Anna Croft couldn't help but laugh when she saw the name written above the introduction.

> Demon King of Salvation (Mid-level Warrior).
>
> —Summon Cost: 100D

A mixture of a premonition of 'no way', and a sense of despair of 'it can't be', Anna Croft used 'summon' as if possessed.

And a moment later.

[The target responded to the summoning.]

A message was heard.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 961 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (4)

A dazzling halo of summoning light rose. Selena Kim spoke, as if suddenly reminded of something.

"Anna, if it's the 'Demon King of Salvation'—"

"It's the man we met at the Washington Dome."

But there was no guarantee that this was truly him. He vanished with the destruction of the Fear Realm, and his whereabouts remained unknown for eight years. Eight years was a long time.

「Some times pass quickly, some slowly.」

Those eight years, which to the Constellations seemed like fleeting moments, often felt like time had stopped for Anna Croft. Perhaps it was the memories of the 40th round's meeting with him and the Fear Realm. For the past eight years, Anna Croft has been using [Future Sight] frequently. Knowing that [Future Sight] frequently malfunctioned after the Fear Realm Incident, she pursued his shadow in the navigable futures.

Eight years have passed. And Anna Croft has never encountered him in any future.

"It can't really be him, though."

"Why do you think so? There aren't many beings with that name."

Anna Croft shook her head at Selena Kim's comment.

"This isn't the first time."

"Huh?"

Over the course of hundreds of battles, Anna Croft had seen similar names on the list of allies. Names like Kim Dokja, the Demon King of Salvation, and the King of Fear.

"The allies' nicknames are chosen by the allies themselves."

At first, Anna was hopeful. She hoped it could be him. She hoped he had truly returned from that hellish Fear Realm Incident.

But the summoned were foolish, unaware of where they had been summoned. They were incarnations. All of them had participated in the 'sponsored summons' of the Constellations.

It was a vicious prank by the Constellations, who had overheard her battle.

"Then again..."

"He's obviously just an idiot imitating him."

The real her wouldn't have wasted 100D on someone like this, wasting her chance to summon. That would only bring amusement to the Constellations who played such a mischievous prank.

"But why did you summon this person?"

"That's..."

And why did she choose this person?

It was difficult to explain the exact reason. Perhaps she was glad to see that name again at this very moment, when her comrade Selena Kim was already in the fight. Or perhaps her [Future Sight] had malfunctioned for so long that she had gone slightly crazy.

But a romantic recorder might record her current state of mind like this:

「Even if this was nothing more than a mischievous prank by the Constellations—the moment she saw that name, this world... The universe, the <Star Stream>, seemed to be speaking to her.」

"I don't know."

She knew she shouldn't say that. Most of the incarnations summoned by the Constellations' pranks were those who had been inevitably collateralized by the Constellations.

Anna Croft thought of the countless Kim Dokjas, the Demon Kings of Salvation, and the Kings of Fear who had died before her.

Perhaps this time, she wouldn't be able to save the summoned. So now, her story was nothing more than a stinging resignation to an unchangeable tragedy.

"Without a glimpse of the future, I can only make such ordinary choices."

The summoned finally emerged from the hazy smoke. Anna Croft gazed at him, her eyes glowing crimson. Just as she was about to examine what kind of idiot it was this time, the eye that had activated [Eye of the Great Demon] began to sting. Anna Croft held her breath involuntarily. She had experienced something similar before.

"Now you understand."

The moment the man's voice rang through the smoke, Anna Croft felt the boundaries between past, present, and future blur for a moment. Even as she wondered if this moment might be a plaything of the Constellations, and as she swore she couldn't be shaken, her mind refused to listen.

It was true. There were many incarnations in the world who bore the nickname 'Demon King of Salvation'. But,

"That's how people who can't see the future live."

There was undoubtedly only one man who could say something like that with a sly smile. Still, Anna harbored doubts to the very end. Was this all an illusion created by the Constellations? Was her malfunctioning [Future Sight], her 'Eye of the Great Demon' displaying a delusion?

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', remembers you.]

A story, flowing from his entire being, confirmed his identity.

"Have you forgotten my face?"

Selena Kim stepped forward in place of Anna Croft, who was still unable to respond.

"My goodness, it really was you."

"Selena Kim."

Watching the two people firmly shaking hands, Anna Croft struggled to regain her senses. As the scene she had longed to see became reality, a strange resentment welled up within her.

"Why did you come, you...?"

"You summoned me."

"You're not the kind of person who would come just because I called."

Their reunion after eight long years. Anna Croft felt uncharacteristically bitter in the face of such a reunion.

"I."

Anna Croft, her lips pursed, lowered her head and stuttered.

"How much I—"

She couldn't tell the man before her the whole story. During her stay on the Island of the Reincarnation, and after entering the prelude to Ragnarok, she had used countless methods to search for his life or death.

How many carrier pigeons and messages she had sent, she couldn't tell.

The man never responded, and so Anna Croft was certain of his death.

And now, just as she was finally able to resign herself, she finally felt the long-awaited return of her life. Just as she was about to let go of her beliefs and even her life, he reappeared.

['Summoning Helper' will end soon.]

Anna Croft raised her head and thought with her sluggish mind.

"Run away."

"Huh?"

"Run away. Even now, I'm sure you can get another ticket."

The man looked at Anna Croft carefully and asked again.

"Do you really want that?"

Anna Croft nodded.

"Yes."

The man smiled brightly.

"Interesting."

The man said, taking a brisk step closer.

"You're afraid I'll die now."

Anna Croft instinctively took a step back.

"No. I just…"

The hastily crafted excuse struggled to hold together. The man stared at Anna Croft in silence. Though he simply stared, Anna Croft knew that his gaze was reading her.

It was the same before. Someone who could read and guess people's minds at will. And even more so because it was so accurate. Her relationship with him had always been one of injustice.

"I hate that you came here."

And yet, for the past eight years, Anna Croft had missed that injustice a little.

"How on earth could you possibly answer this summons? Did you even know where this place was in the first place?"

The man she met after eight years still gazed at the sky with those same unfair eyes.

"This is the playground of the Constellations. The coliseum of the Constellations that wish to postpone 'Ragnarok' forever."

As if responding to the man's gaze, a dizzying number of Constellations twinkled in the sky.

With their presence intact, this stage would never be destroyed.

"You came all this way knowing that?"

The man answered, as if he wasn't at all afraid of the starlight.

"Yes."

"Why?"

"You summoned me."

Anna Croft thought. Even if she had been able to use [Future Sight], she wouldn't have known what to say now.

And as always, the man easily filled the void of the future she couldn't fill.

"I'm sorry I'm so late, Kim Anna-ssi."

The man still called her by a strange name.

Faced with his sly tone, all Anna Croft could do was act like 'Kim Anna', as the man had said.

"... Yes."

With a deep sigh, Kim Anna barely took a step forward and extended her hand.

"It's been a while, Kim End-ssi."

It was their first reunion in eight years.

---

The first thing I did upon entering Valhalla Hall was to come up with a nickname.

「Kim Anna-ssi is in danger.」

It was clear how the situation was unfolding.

['Summoning the Helper' begins!]

The summoning of the helper, and the game's content. This 'preliminary battle' was undoubtedly inspired by the 'Mythical Battlefield' of the Demon King Selection Tournament.

Somewhere, the 'Mass-Production Maker' smiled meaningfully. In this seemingly imaginary landscape, I pondered.

「If there's a difference from the 'Mythical Battlefield', it's that there's a 'summoning system' here.」

Each team's commander could summon additional allies using their 'summoning costs', and indeed, the summoning was still ongoing.

[…The team summoned the 'Thunder-Eating Bird!']

[…The team summoned the 'General of Vanara'!]

The newly added enemy of Kim Anna seemed to have quite a lot of 'summoning costs'.

[Your required summoning cost is 100D.]

Fortunately or unfortunately, my required summoning cost wasn't high.

[I wonder which idiot will respond to that team this time.]

[Will it be that same idiot again?]

I turned my head to the Constellations' conversation, and saw the General wiping the fragments of stories flowing from his head. Only then did it begin to make sense. Was that why the General was in that state?

I thought again. I looked at the nickname creation window.

「I have to make Anna Croft summon me.」

With Anna's personality, she would surely meticulously review every summoned. So there was no way she wouldn't see the nickname I'd created.

The problem was what kind of 'nickname' to choose.

Several candidates quickly flashed through my mind. The first one that came to mind was 'Kim End'.

Perhaps if I chose 'Kim End', Anna Croft would definitely recognize me. And of course, 'Kim End' was a name proven by the history she and I shared.

Nevertheless, I ultimately chose not to choose that name.

Because...

「Anna Croft said. Don't save herself, save her comrades.」

I don't know what happened, but when I met Anna Croft again after eight years, she was a different person.

If it were me, I wouldn't know.

If she thought of me as a colleague, she might not have called me with the name 'Kim End'.

"So you named yourself 'Demon King of Salvation'?"

"Yes."

"No, why on earth?"

"You don't like the 'Demon King of Salvation', do you?"

"Me?"

"You lost allies with Asgard because of the Demon King of Salvation, and that's why you ended up like this. I was sure you would hate that name."

"…"

"Seeing you summoned me, it seems my prediction was correct."

I nodded, secretly pleased, but Kim Anna's expression was strange.

"You really—"

I wondered if it was just my imagination.

Is it just me?

Kim Anna, whom I hadn't seen in eight years, seemed to have become a little more resentful.

I understand. According to 'Ways of Survival', even Yoo Joonghyuk's personality was at its worst when he had regressed about 500 times.

Kim Anna sighed lightly and spoke.

"Okay. Let's leave that aside. So what are we going to do now?"

"We have to fight."

"Do you think this is a winnable fight?"

"We've cleared worse scenarios, haven't we?"

"If you're trusting my [Future Sight], I'd tell you to escape immediately."

As expected. I'd expected it.

"Is [Future Sight] blocked?"

Anna Croft nodded gravely.

"Yes. My [Future Sight] won't work on this battlefield."

The fact that [Future Sight] didn't work meant that there was a hidden element in this scenario that was interfering with [Future Sight].

「And I knew full well when her [Future Sight] would break down.」

I'd felt it from the moment I entered the battlefield. Every breath of air in this world had a terribly unpleasant stench.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', bares his greedy teeth.]

The green meadows of the stadium. I could see at a glance the stories flowing vigorously beneath the plains.

Looking at them, I understood precisely why Anna Croft's [Future Sight] had been completely ineffective on this battlefield.

「This 'outpost' battlefield is made of my brother's flesh and blood.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

# 962 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (5)

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Anna Croft continued.

"To be precise, it wasn't like this from the beginning. The noise was intense, but there were times when I could see a glimpse of the future."

I nodded and read my brother's stories, which I could sense from the battlefield.

In fact, this battlefield wasn't entirely filled with my brother's blood and murder. In this battlefield, I felt not only my brother's stories, but also the true stories of the Outer Gods, the vengeful spirits of the incarnations.

[The 1265th 'Outpost' is about to begin.]

The battle had already been repeated 1265 times.

"I see what's going on."

The incarnations who participated in the 'Outpost' were all ascended from lower-level scenarios. Some, like the 'New Murim District', had strict screening requirements, while others had more lenient conditions.

「This battlefield is steeped in the stories of the dead incarnations.」

Unlike other rounds, the 'Ascended' in this round used 'D-Coins' in the lower-level scenarios to enhance their incarnation bodies and abilities.

'D-Coins' are a fusion of my brothers' stories and the power of the Fear Realm. The incarnations who used these stories to enhance themselves died here, and as a result, this 'battlefield'—

"This battlefield is a kind of highly concentrated story—the very essence of 'Fear'."

It became a vast land of stories.

[Your stories are reacting to the battlefield.]

I couldn't even begin to imagine how many incarnations had perished here.

「A myth forged with the blood of the incarnations.」

If some of my brother's stories were ingrained in this battlefield, it wasn't surprising that Kim Anna's [Future Sight] was limited. Her [Future Sight] would be disrupted whenever Kim Dokja intervened in the future.

[Five minutes left until the battle begins.]

Kim Anna spoke urgently at the system message that appeared.

"We're really running out of time."

"Let's start with our participants."

I wondered if there might be even one familiar face. Perhaps another reader, or a major character I'd met.

"U, uu, ugh…"

"I'm going to die. I'm going to die."

But most of those summoned to our team were in poor condition. Most of them had nameless Constellations as their backing, or were abandoned after being used as terminal incarnations of a vast Nebula.

It was strange. Still, if they had come this far through the 'Ascension' system, they should have possessed basic combat prowess.

"Please, spare me. Please, spare me. I won't do it again. Constellations. Please."

"My, my coin, my coin—!"

Why were all the members of this team like this?

"Has it always been like this?"

Anna Croft nodded silently at my answer. Perhaps she had been fighting unfairly in such extreme conditions for so long.

"I never expected anything like that."

Since even Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been through over a thousand rounds, wouldn't have made such a face, I tried to make a joke.

"I'm here."

"Even so, you're just a mid-level warrior…"

"Because I hid my power."

"The Ragnarok ranking system is never wrong. Your rank won't change even if you hide your power."

Anna Croft, still seemingly disbelieving, sighed deeply and added,

"And even if you did indeed hide your power, this will be difficult."

If she, who had experienced the Fear Realm with me, could say this, then there must be more to this scenario than I knew.

"The Constellations that participated as helpers this time aren't 'first-time participants'."

As expected.

As soon as I heard her words, I looked around at the enemy members. All members of the enemy side were at least 'Narrative-grade' Constellations or their incarnations. Three stood out:

The General of Vanara.

The Thunder-Eating Bird.

The Founder of Humanity.

The selection was so impressive that it brought to mind the 'Demon King Selection Tournament'.

Judging by the perceived 'level', all three had grown in power since the main story's 'Demon King Selection Tournament'.

Anna Croft glared at the Constellations and said,

"I've already fought them several times."

"Could you elaborate?"

"The team that wins the 'Outpost' isn't necessarily promoted. Those who win on the battlefield remain as spectators and can continue to participate in the 'Battlefield'."

From the moment I first heard Anna Croft's story, I suspected such a system might exist. The number of Constellations occupying the Colosseum's audience was far greater than I expected.

「The Colosseum of the Constellations, who wish to permanently postpone 'Ragnarok'.」

The stars here are all cowards, fearing the annihilation of the world.

In other words, they were deliberately building up their strength through repeated 'preliminary battles' and holding off on participating in the main battlefield.

Like a veteran who, even after reaching a high level, refuses to leave the beginner hunting grounds and continues to slaughter.

"We can't win."

The despair she'd endured was finally beginning to dawn on her.

The situation was indeed dire.

[Team 'Zarathustra' currently has 11 members.]

In the midst of all this, our team was even one member short.

"Can we summon an ally again?"

"We don't have enough summoning costs."

"How do we acquire costs?"

"You can either receive support from the Constellations or exchange them with 'D-Coins' acquired during the match."

D-Coins? Wait, then…

[Trading goods is not possible within this battlefield.]

I see. Can't I give it to her?

"And even if it costs a small amount, there are no warriors we can summon anyway."

"Why?"

"In this situation, who would help our team? At least a Constellation on the Korean peninsula was helping us until recently…"

It was clear who that person was.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', cheers for your strength.]

This time, perhaps I didn't have the cost to summon that General. It was a contentious situation for me. Perhaps Kim Anna summoned me instead of the General.

I spoke to her as if to comfort her.

"Don't worry. We have warriors who can help us."

"Even if we have warriors, they're not of average rank—"

"A special prize warrior."

Anna Croft's expression changed for the first time at the mention of special rank. But her complexion quickly darkened.

"I don't know who that is, but summoning a special-level warrior will require at least 10,000 summoning costs. You won't be able to collect that much in one match."

"Of course. In this match."

Anna Croft tilted her head at my question and asked back.

"What do you mean?"

"Let's focus on the match for now. What did you say the pool would be like?"

Anna Croft briefly explained the match's mechanics. She gave two key points to remember:

One, never lose.

Two, pay attention to the 'Prophecies' that randomly appear during the match.

As expected, the Prophecies were similar to the 'Crests' that appeared in the 'Demon King Selection Tournament'.

"There are disasters or objects that appear alongside the Prophecies. Defeating or destroying them will grant you the Prophecies..."

"So your team's power will be boosted."

"How did you know?"

"I know of similar games. So how many Prophecies are there in total?"

"This battlefield is small, so there will be three Prophecies."

"So collecting them all means victory."

"Theoretically, yes."

Anna Croft also explained special devices like 'bush'.

"I understand. 'Bush' are places used in times of emergency or to conceal oneself from enemies."

"Yes. That's useless if the enemy is using an item related to [Intelligence], though... Oh, and each bush has its own additional effects."

"Effects?"

"For example, some bushes increase attack or defense simply by hiding in them, while others impose specific penalties. Since the battlefield itself is based on 'Fear', the effects of bushes are somewhat imperfect. I heard that sometimes entering a bush can cause a player to go missing."

"Go missing?"

"Yes. They say there are those who disappeared during the 'outpost' like that. I've never witnessed them in any of the battles I've participated in, though…"

This is interesting information.

I mentally summoned the 'Unchanging One'.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Unchanging One', responds to your call.]

It seemed he had been eavesdropping on our conversation. I told him to look up the relevant records and then returned to Anna's story.

"Our side is at a disadvantage in terms of combat power, so the best we can do is hold out until the prophecy is revealed. And…"

"We must somehow secure the first prophecy."

Prophecies strengthen the team's combat power, so in this situation, this was the only strategy with a chance of success.

But Kim Anna looked utterly unsure.

"Actually, it's been the same strategy all along."

"Have any of those operations ever been successful?"

"We've stolen the first prophecy a few times…"

So, despite stealing the first prophecy, they've never won. Anna Croft, taking a few deep breaths, continued.

"We must seize the first prophecy at all costs. That way, we have a slight chance of victory. The problem is, the battle is likely to end before that. In most battles, our team is annihilated before the 'first prophecy' is announced."

"…"

"Kim End-ssi."

"Yes."

"Why are you laughing?"

Anna Croft, frowning, was about to say something when something like a small firecracker exploded above her head.

[The 'Skuld's Golden Dice Hall' has opened in the 'Valhalla Hall'!]

Selena Kim, who was listening nearby, let out a small groan, and Anna Croft, her expression crumpled, cursed in a Korean manner.

"The damn party has begun."

Skuld's Golden Dice Hall.

I'd heard of this before.

[The 'Constellations' Wager' begins.]

The gods' gambling hall, opened whenever a major story event takes place in <Asgard>. I had a rough idea of what it was like. Perhaps, with each match, the stars would place bets on the winner and loser.

[There are currently no bets on this battlefield.]

But there were no bets on this battlefield. Perhaps it was because they had decided it wouldn't even be decided in the first place.

I opened my mouth, looking at the system message.

"Let's use the same strategy this time. We'll hold out somehow and until the first prophecy appears."

"It'll be tough. They have no reason to waste time—"

"I have a plan."

Kim Anna narrowed her eyes, as if thinking about something in my words.

"I won't listen to that plan."

"Why?"

"You're planning to sacrifice yourself again."

How on earth did Kim Dokja's image become so ingrained that even Kim Anna was thinking this way?

I waved my hand, looking aggrieved.

"I don't make sacrifices."

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', nods.]

Anna Croft sneered.

"Are you telling me to believe you when you spout such stories?"

I paused, meeting Kim Anna's trembling eyes for a moment.

[Waiting time ends.]

I saw her eyes slowly turning to despair. Without ignoring her despair, I spoke in a clear voice.

"Kim Anna-ssi, it's been eight years."

[The 1265th battlefield opens.]

[The match begins.]

A vast meadow opened up. A cloud of dust rose in the distance.

"Just as you've been through many things, so have I. I can't share them all right now, but __"

As soon as the battle began, the Constellations charged, shattering the ground.

"At least I can tell you one thing for sure."

Looking at the Constellations approaching with a menacing air, I added calmly.

"They will never end the match before the 'First Prophecy' begins."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 963 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (6)

"What the heck...?"

Anna Croft added urgently, watching the Constellations rushing toward her.

"This isn't the time to be complacent! They've already won countless matches! They probably used their summoning costs differently—"

I could sense it, too. The Constellations rushing toward me all had a special aura surrounding them.

[The participants on that team have used the 'Incarnation Body Enhancement Pack II'!]

The Incarnation Body Enhancement Pack. I expected that, but the 'summoning costs' earned through matches aren't limited to 'summoning helpers'.

Judging by the way they swarmed in from the very start, it seemed like they were going to tear us apart before the First Prophecy was even spoken.

[Trample on them.]

The mantra resonated majestically. The 'Thunder-Eating Bird' flying at the forefront roared.

[The Constellation, 'Thunder-Eating Bird', has acquired an acceleration buff!]

Orb-like objects were placed throughout the skyway.

The 'Thunder-Eating Bird' swallowed the objects with its massive mouth, accelerating even further and unleashing lightning strikes at every obstacle in its path.

Anna Croft shouted, looking at the pitch-black grassland path.

"Everyone, run!"

The incarnations, their faces paling, began to flee frantically.

But Anna and the incarnations knew this. There was no way to escape that Constellation. Within ten seconds at the latest, we would face that mad birdhead.

「What if I used the stories of the 'Demon King of Salvation'?」

I weighed the stories within myself, comparing their scales to mine.

In a sense, now that they perceived me as a 'low-level warrior' offered an opportunity.

"Kim Dokja! You too, hurry—"

"It's okay."

The distance between me and the 'Thunder-Eating bird' was now a stone's throw. It would reach us in five seconds.

"I told you."

Four seconds.

"Those guys..."

Three seconds.

"Absolutely not, the game will not end until the 'First Prophecy' appears."

Two seconds.

"Stop that nonsense, please... ah."

A desperate Anna Croft turned to me, her expression a testament to her resignation. She stumbled, then hugged me, as if sacrificing her own incarnation body to save me.

And then, lightning struck from the pitch-black sky.

One second.

A deafening blue. The lightning struck right before my eyes, incinerating the meadow a fraction of an inch ahead. The 'Thunder-Eating bird' folded its massive wings and landed in front of me. The majesty of the Constellation, the Narrative-grade Constellation, revealing its gigantic incarnation body alongside the gale, was truly magnificent. I recalled the information about him.

「The thunder-eating bird—'Garuda'. One of the eight mountains of <Steady>, the right-hand man of Vishnu, the 'Guardian of Time', one of the mythical trinity of <Vedas>, the king of birds.」

Could he possibly display this level of power by the 85th scenario, even if it were only a matter of probability?

「This was the true power of the 'Narrative-grade Constellation'.」

If it had been a while ago, I would have been intimidated by its imposing presence, but now I was completely unfazed.

Garuda, his massive wings folded, gazed down at me, his golden beak twitching as if in awe of me.

[This is the first time I've seen an incarnation like this, and you're so brave. What is your identity? What city gate did you come from?]

Ignoring him, I lightly patted the half-conscious Kim Anna on the shoulder and offered her food and shelter.

"It's okay. That bird can't harm us. It's well-trained."

Following this, other Constellations arrived.

The second to stop before me was a giant ape clad in massive armor.

「Hanuman, the General of Vanara」

With a cry of, Hanuman lowered his massive club and let out a thunderous roar.

[You damn bird-head! I told you to slow down! You haven't killed them all already, have you?]

Garuda, who snapped a discontented question, wiggled his long beak and replied,

[We haven't killed a single one yet. Did we really receive a hold order?]

[Yes!]

[Every hour? Is there a someone here protected by the Giant Nebula?]

Garuda shook his massive bird-head, seemingly in incomprehension.

Anna Croft, who had finally regained her senses, looked at me with a puzzled expression.

—What have you done now?

"You don't have to use Transmission. Those guys don't care what we say."

I watched the Constellations, their massive incarnation bodies swell, chattering away. Like gourmets facing a boring meal, they were busy exchanging mantras, ignoring us.

Anna Croft, glancing furtively at me, continued to ask,

—Have you obtained the blessing of some Mythical Constellation? Have you joined a Giant Nebula?"

"If so, why would I stay here? Why would I join another team?"

—Then how...

I shrugged and looked up at the sky.

"Simple."

There was a faintly twinkling golden dice symbol.

[A 'bet' is currently underway on this battlefield.]

Then the Constellations in the audience watching the match began to glow brightly. I glared at the sinister light, then grinned and added,

"I suppose that means someone doesn't want us to 'die'."

[Come on, come on, this isn't a match you see every day!]

Skuld, the god of gambling and lending, continued to solicit customers with his fierce pronouncements.

But no spectators showed up. That's understandable.

[Team Zarathustra vs. Team Vedas]

The difference in strength between the teams was so great that even a bet wouldn't be possible.

[Ugh, this is a total mess.]

[Why are you even offering a bet on something like this? You seem to have lost your touch, Skuld.]

Skuld's expression hardened at the sarcasm coming from all around, and he licked his lips.

[Haha, audience members. Don't be like that, why don't you bet—]

[Who would bet coins on a match like that at a time like this? Huh?]

A time like this. The Constellations were right.

Recently, the Constellations' spending throughout Valhalla Hall had significantly decreased.

It's already been three years since the hall opened. Over the years, thousands of battles have been held, and thousands of bets have been made. Most of the Constellations that were considered 'whales' on the board have moved to the main battlefield, leaving only cautious charlatans and fools who only wager small amounts of money on the betting table.

This was a difficult situation for Skuld, who relied on betting fees to make a living.

He needed to somehow create a provocative betting game to get the Constellations to participate, but there was no sign of a major game opening...

Skuld was about to abandon the betting game when a dazzlingly gleaming head obscured his vision.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is looking at you.]

Skuld also knew this Constellation. It was a Constellation of the highest rank on the Korean Peninsula. It had managed to climb to the 'Valhalla Hall', but it wasn't destined to rise above that. One of the listless Constellations, languishing in this hall, waiting for the battle on the 'main battlefield' to end.

[Oh, right, bald. What's going on?]

At his question, the missionary silently reached into his pocket and pulled out a D-coin.

[Huh? You want to join the bet?]

The missionary nodded, and Skuld chuckled and asked.

[Which team are you betting on?]

The missionary, his face broken and his pronunciation difficult, stuttered as Skuld's expression contorted.

[Are you serious? You're betting on that team?]

The missionary had called out the team as 'Zarathustra'.

Skuld hesitated for a moment, then asked again.

[You know what team that is, don't you? If you bet on that, you'll definitely lose.]

The missionary smiled as if it was okay. Skuld watched him quietly before speaking.

[I've heard the rumors, but you really are out of your mind. Why would you bet on that team? Do you even have a favorite incarnation?]

Skold was well aware of the rumors about the Ambassador of the Mission. The story of a mad Constellation repeatedly supporting a prophet's team whose defeat was certain.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', smiles bitterly.]

Skold had seen Constellations like the Ambassador of the Mission countless times.

A Constellation that burned all its stories and dedicated its life to a single story.

It was a common mistake made by Constellations gripped by the fear of impending destruction.

[Staking all its remaining light on the last story of its choice. A romantic story, but...]

Skold added with a bitter smile.

[Those coins won't even open the 'bet'.]

The Bald General took out a total of 300 D-Coins. This was far short of the minimum required to open the bet. But that wasn't the only problem.

[And is now the time for you to make a bet? You haven't forgotten that the repayment of the loan you borrowed last time is just around the corner, have you?]

The General' shoulders flinched at the mention of a loan.

To remain in Valhalla Hall, you must continuously deposit a certain amount of coins, or D-coins.

And the General had already borrowed coins from Skuld once to cover the repayment.

[The loan is due in three days. If you don't have the coins by then, you'll have to pay them in shills.]

The General lowered his head, and Skuld patted his shoulder with a mock, sinister smile.

[Well, if you really want to participate in the bet, there's a way.]

Skuld said to the General, who slowly raised his head as if asking what was going on.

[You know a lot of Constellations from other Korean peninsulas, don't you? Bring them to the betting table. Then I'm willing to make an additional loan, if that's the case.]

The ambassador's face slowly flushed red.

[The Constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', says he has no intention of betraying his comrades.]

Skuld smiled wryly. It was an expected response.

He doesn't know what lies within that small piece of land, but based on his experience, the Constellations on the Korean Peninsula have a strangely strong mutual trust.

That's why Skuld's true intention was this.

[Or, there's another way. Stake every 'story' you have, and I'll lend you about 5,000 D-coins.]

At the mention of 5,000 D-coins, the General's head snapped up again.

Skuld's even more sinister words lingered in his ears.

[Your goal isn't to make money from that 'game', is it? You want to save the prophet of <Asgard>, right?]

In fact, Skuld knew the missionary's purpose. It wasn't about betting coins because the missionary believed that the 'Zarathustra' team would truly win.

「A match where a bet is placed can attract the attention of the Constellations.」

The moment a 'bet' is deemed worthwhile, the main incarnation of the match is highly likely to be designated as the 'Resurrected'.

[If you bet on that incarnation, they'll likely be designated as the Resurrected next time. You hope that incarnation survives, no matter what.]

The General didn't answer.

Skuld murmured.

[You're so cruel. Knowing that incarnation wants to die more than anyone else, why are you trying to save her? Do you want her to despair even more? Or—]

The General remained silent. Skuld added with a sigh.

[Anyway, the match is about to begin. What are you going to do? Do you want to borrow coins?]

The General's eyes slowly began to glow.

Skuld already knew the General's answer. He didn't know why he wanted to revive that incarnation. However, a Constellation devoted to a story will often sacrifice its own life for it. The 'Bald General of Justice' before him was in the grip of such madness.

Suddenly, the General Samyeondae's lips parted in a twisted manner, and just as Skuld was about to open his mouth with a satisfied expression,

"Samyeongdae-nim, you were here."

Someone barged in between them.

Skuld frowned at the unexpected intruder and said,

[I'm sorry, but we're in the middle of an important conversation—]

"Nice to meet you, too, General. Do you remember this? I still have the mat you gave me. Of course. It's my most prized possession."

[Look here.]

"You want to make a bet? Why? Are you bored?"

The intruder, oblivious to Skuld's reaction, clasped both of the ambassador's hands and began to chatter. He treated him as if he were his own grandfather.

"General, have you ever heard of voice phishing?"

[…]

"You don't know? Yes, that could be true. It's okay. Anyway, there are so many scary scammers out there. These days, it's so dangerous. How could you borrow money so recklessly?"

[…]

"If you look closely, you're a good person? No, come to your senses. Ambassador, you're being gaslighted. I know because I've been fooled by those narrow-eyed people all the time. They're just scamming you to get your story."

Skuld's mouth fell open in shock. He'd been criticized for running a gambling ring, but this was the first time he'd been insulted like this by a complete stranger.

No matter how he looked at him, he was a complete stranger. How could he have the nerve to…

"Huh? Why did you have to bet on her? Huh, that's the point?"

That's when he noticed the incarnation's equipment. Although it was grimy here and there, the equipment was steeped in a deep story. The incarnation's robust muscles were also visible.

The incarnation finally sighed deeply, looked at him, and then strode over to him.

"How much does that bet start at?"

Skuld pondered for a moment before answering.

[You need at least 1,000 D-Coins to make the bet count. If you want a bigger bet, you'll need at least 10,000 D-Coins.]

"Ten thousand D-Coins?"

[Why? Is that too much?]

Skuld knew. No Constellation would bet 10,000 D-Coins these days. Even so, the reason he'd asked such an absurd amount was simply to discourage ambassador Samyeongdae and that uninvited guest.

But...

"Let's do it."

Smiling, the incarnation pulled the D-Coins from his pocket.

"It's cheaper than I thought?"

Skuld doubted his eyes several times, counting the D-coins the incarnation had pulled out. The missionary, watching from the side, also widened his eyes.

「It's a 'big deal'.」

The moment Skuld saw the D-coins, that was the only thought that filled his mind. But the moment Skuld reached out for it...

"Wait."

The incarnation grabbed his wrist and said.

"I'll make one condition."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 964 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (7)

Samyeondaesa recalled the moment he first entered the 'Valhalla Hall'. The explosions of cannons and the excited voices of the incarnations.

「"Samyeondaesa-nim."」

The young incarnation's face sparkled with a strange fervor.

「"We've come this far. We've made it. Maybe we can even make it to the final scenario."」

The incarnation he had chosen after much deliberation.

When he first saw the incarnation, the Samyeondaesa hesitated to become their sponsor. Because of their poor overall stats, the incarnation had been shunned by the other constellations.

[The constellation, the 'Careful Star', says it would be foolish to become the sponsor of such an incarnation.]

His observation of that continent's scenario was merely a coincidence. The incarnation of the Korean Peninsula scenario, which he had been observing for a long time, had gone missing, and the Samyeondaesa wandered around the early scenarios for a while,

perhaps hoping for a 'what if'. Another hopeful hope: that he might discover another incarnation.

Of course, even Samyeondaesa knew well that such a thing wasn't common. Some stories only happen once in a lifetime, and only after they've passed do we realize that fact.

Nevertheless, the constellations lingered and wandered the lower scenario regions because their thirst for stories could only be quenched with stories.

「"Help me! Help me!"」

Even if it wasn't the same story.

「"Please—!"」

The incarnation he discovered was a boy from Connecticut, California.

An incarnation of a different nationality than Samyeondaesa.

With the Korean incarnation already under his control, he couldn't possibly enter into a contract with an incarnation of another nationality.

[The constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is observing you.]

He still can't forget the incarnation's first words, which startled him as he glanced at him.

「"Do you happen to know incarnation Kim Dokja?"」

Only upon hearing the name did the Samyeondaesa realize.

「In fact, the incarnation he truly desired was 'Kim Dokja'.」

But so many constellations desired him, that Samyeondaesa naturally fell down the pecking order of potential partners.

So, at some point, Samyeondaesa decided to become his fan instead of his sponsor.

He doesn't have to be his incarnation. He just wanted to support him. He wanted to enjoy the story of his life together and witness the ■■ of the world he pursues.

But with the end of the Fear Realm, he magically disappeared, leaving only Samyeondaesa, who had supported him, alone.

[The constellation, 'Maegeumjijon', leaves the channel in search of a new story.]

[The constellation, 'Seoaeilpil', leaves the channel in search of a new story.]

Even as the surrounding constellations left the channel one by one, Samyeondaesa remained, hoping that Kim Dokja might reappear somewhere in the world. That's how the past eight years of Samyeondaesa flowed.

「"I want to be like that person."」

Even now, Samyeondaesa couldn't quite explain why he chose to become the sponsor behind the incarnation. Perhaps it was because his blond hair resembled Kim Dokja. Or perhaps his narrowed eyes reminded him of Kim Dokja.

[Samyeondaesa became the sponsor behind 'Noah Kim'.]

Or perhaps it was simply because he knew Kim Dokja.

「"Samyeondaesa, this is a secret."」

Traveling with him was enjoyable.

He was eloquent, and for some unknown reason, he was very fond of Kim Dokja.

「"Samyeondaesa, you may not know this, but I've known you since the beginning."」

He often spoke incomprehensibly. Perhaps even in that way, to Samyeondaesa, he resembled Kim Dokja.

「"I can't explain it well, though."」

Contrary to his initially poor abilities, the incarnation often solved scenarios with surprising ideas. He thought and acted like Kim Dokja, and often, in his sleep, he would tell him strange novel stories.

「"If I knew it would become reality, I would have read more... But the translation here is..."」

Thus, the Connecticut-born incarnation and the Korean-born constellation steadily worked their way through the scenarios. They cleared scenarios 20, 30, and 40. In this way, Samyeondaesa gradually forgot about Kim Dokja.

It wasn't the same joy he felt watching Kim Dokja's story, but he felt a distinct happiness as he built up his story.

Finally, when he reached scenario 80, his incarnation asked,

"Master, will we meet again soon?"

There comes a time when every constellation must give up on its own scenario. The moment he realized that this was the end of the story his life could unfold, the story his light could illuminate.

Some constellations crumble in frustration, while others, seeking to elevate their status, take on even more powerful incarnations.

In that respect, Samyeondaesa was truly fortunate.

"You said you were in scenario number 80, Samyeondaesa."

The incarnation he had nurtured finally reached his scenario.

The moment all constellations yearned for had arrived for him.

[See you in scenario number 85.]

Samyeondaesa was filled with anticipation.

He could finally meet his incarnation. With him, perhaps he could even work on the second half of the scenario he had previously abandoned. He could join forces with his incarnation to complete the scenario, and perhaps even reach the end of this world.

[Fight! Make the Korean Peninsula's status known! Never give up!]

With that single anticipation, Samyeondaesa participated in 'Ragnarok'. He fought against the enemies in the preliminary battle. He aimed his spear and sword at unfamiliar constellations of unfamiliar nationalities, ultimately beheading them.

Leaving behind the wailing screams of the incarnations, he made excuses, believing that this was all inevitable. Believing it was a task he had to undertake to meet the incarnation.

And finally, when he returned victoriously to the audience of this Valhalla Hall...

[The execution ceremony begins.]

His incarnation was on the scaffold.

---

"So that's what happened."

Samyeondaesa's story was disjointed and incoherent. The story on his face was muddled.

Nevertheless, Jung Heewon listened attentively to the end.

[The constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is touched by the consideration of the incarnation 'Jung Heewon'.]

He hadn't expected Jung Heewon to say anything. In fact, even if Jung Heewon had said something, Samyeondaesa wouldn't have been able to hear it. His mind was already seething with the incarnation's final voice.

「"Samyeondaesa."」

The incarnation, waving at him from the execution platform, used his final opportunity to speak to his superior.

「"I'm sorry I couldn't keep my promise."」

He still remembered the moment the executioner's blade fell and the incarnation's head fell.

The incarnation rearranged the ridges on his face and barely managed to continue his speech.

[My incarnation was on the 'Prophet's' team.]

In this prelude to 'Ragnarok,' there was a team whose 'defeat' was certain.

The incarnation had heard the rumors well. However, he never imagined that his incarnation would be on that team.

[At first, I hated the Prophet. I thought my incarnation died because of her.]

The constellation, having lost his incarnation, went half-mad.

[If it weren't for her team, my incarnation wouldn't have died.]

All the souls who failed to resurrect in 'Ragnarok' were absorbed into the land of the 'Outpost' and became part of a grand narrative.

On the land where his incarnation died and disappeared, Samyeondaesa cried out quietly.

[That's why I started sponsoring the Prophet.]

The incarnations who receive sponsorship gain the attention of the constellations, and those who receive attention are designated as the next 'Resurrected One'.

[I knew she would be resurrected even without my sponsorship. And yet, I did it anyway...]

As Skuld said, his sponsorship stemmed from a rather base desire.

Samyeondaesa wanted the Prophet, who had caused his incarnation's death, to suffer. He wanted her to be tortured for eternity within the chains of resurrection created by the constellations, clinging to the flimsy thread of hope.

[I watched the Prophet die like that, over and over again, ten times, fifty times, a hundred times... I saw her companions lose and lose again.]

But sitting in the audience of constellations, laughing, chattering, and cursing, watching the Prophet's downfall, Samyeondaesa was overcome by a strange sense of disillusionment.

That day, for the first time, Samyeondaesa noticed that the Prophet, now on the scaffold, was desperately crying out for something.

「"Kill me. I want that incarnation to live, not me."」

As if awakening from a long hypnosis, Samyeondaesa belatedly confirmed the story of the deceased incarnation.

「"I'm sorry I couldn't keep my promise."」

Words he hadn't heard because he was so focused on the voice of the incarnation before his death.

Those words rang in Samyeondaesa's ears.

「"Please! Constellations! Save that incarnation! I want him to live!"」

The expression on the Prophet's face as she cried out, pointing precisely at his incarnation. Looking at the prophet, and then at the constellations mocking her, Samyeondaesa wondered, 'Who truly killed his incarnation?'

[I still supported the prophet. However...]

Samyeondaesa gradually increased the amount of support. He sold stories and relics. Every time he did something like that, he knew the ladder to the 'next scenario' would break. Yet, he couldn't stop.

[On a whim, I suddenly wanted to see a certain scene.]

Valhalla Hall filled with cheers. Looking at the audience of constellations, gathered like a solid castle, Samyeondaesa said,

[Just once, to see her win.]

He knew it was impossible. Nevertheless, Samyeondaesa sponsored his coins as if reciting a mantra. He sponsored the prophet and bet on her team. He poured all his coins into it. When his coins were almost depleted, he borrowed money from Skuld.

Knowing full well that it was irreversible, knowing that if he continued like this, this would truly be his last ■■, the missionary did it.

[I'm grateful to you.]

And just now, his last bet was complete.

[You bet on Team 'Zarathustra'.]

The match began, and the battlefield opened. With wild cheers, the constellations on the screen lit up.

[Thanks to you, I was able to make the 'final bet'. If I'd gone this far, even that dead child would understand.]

The golden dice rolled violently in the air.

It was spinning. It was evidence that the constellations were flocking to the gambling table.

[Someone bet on Team 'Veda'.]

[Someone bet on Team 'Veda'.]

…

The bet just kept growing.

Perhaps the scale of this gambling table would be one of the largest since the opening of 'Valhalla Hong'.

[But let me ask you one thing.]

But the scale of this table wasn't simply because Jung Heewon bet so many coins.

[Why on earth did you... place such an 'additional bet'?]

At the ambassador's words, Jung Heewon saw the 'additional bet condition' flashing in the air.

[There is an 'additional bet condition' in this match!]

[All spectators can bet on the 'additional bet condition'!]

[The 'additional bet condition' is 'when the match ends'.]

1. The match ends before the first prophecy appears.
2. The match ends after the first prophecy appears.

That was the 'additional bet' that Jung Heewon had proposed to Skuld.

「"I'll bet on Team 'Zarathustra'. However, I'll place an additional bet on 'the match ending before the first prophecy appears'."」

It was puzzling.

There was absolutely no reason to make such an outrageous bet. Nevertheless, Skuld accepted Jung Heewon's offer.

「"How about an additional 100,000 D-coins?"」

Not just 100,000, but a whopping 200,000 D-coins had flowed into the betting table, and he had no reason to refuse.

[You can never win this bet.]

Samyeondaesa already knew from his long experience. Skuld's 'Golden Dice Special' was a game orchestrated by the so-called big shots.

[Someone bet an additional 5,000 D-coins on 'The match ends after the first prophecy appears!']

[Someone bet an additional 10,000 D-coins on 'The match ends after the first prophecy appears!']

…

As a huge amount of coins flowed into the gambling table, naturally, hidden whales emerged, eager to gobble up the blind money.

But Jung Heewon remained calm.

"No, it's all going according to plan."

The next moment, as if by magic, a surprising change appeared in the stadium.

[Oh, ohhh—!]

Amidst the cheers of the crowd, Samyeondaesa also widened his eyes.

The constellations that had been rushing towards Team Zarathustra, as if ready to crush them at any moment, stopped one by one, leaving their targets right before their eyes.

[Hahahaha! I knew it!]

[Just playing with them!]

Amidst the excited crowd, Samyeondaesa felt goosebumps.

[You, no way.]

Gazing at Jung Heewon, who silently watched the match, Samyeondaesa was amazed by the incarnation's insight.

[To buy the Prophet a little more time…]

The constellations within the battlefield had already conspired with the Skuld's 'big hands'. Therefore, the current situation was clear.

「The constellations within the stadium will not end the match immediately in order to seize Jung Heewon's amassed wealth.」

Jung Heewon likely anticipated this. Jung Heewon had invested a whopping 200,000 D-coins to buy time for Team Zarathustra.

「If this development continues, the Prophet's team can avoid annihilation until the 'First Prophecy' appears.」

Samyeondaesa, moved by Jung Heewon's determination, secretly wiped away tears.

"What are you talking about? I bet to win?"

Jung Hweewon muttered something strange.

"Oh, by the way, I don't know how to split that money if I win."

[What on earth are you talking about—]

Samyeondaesa grew anxious. Upon closer inspection, he saw that this incarnation truly intended to win the bet.

[The Prophet's team will truly win…]

And a moment later, Samyeondaesa's eyes widened. While no other constellations noticed, Samyeondaesa was the only one who recognized the incarnation.

Jung Heewon, who was watching the same scene, said,

"Isn't that obvious?"

Screen 4: A man approaches the still constellations of 'Veda' with a menacing air.

Amidst the magical scenery, Samyeondaesa stared blankly at his coat fluttering in the air.

「"Someday, I really want to try a scenario like Kim Dokja."」

Jung Heewon said, as if she understood Samyeondaesa's feelings.

"He's over there."

The incarnation that had been missing for the past eight years was there. The incarnation he had searched for, the incarnation he had longed for. Watching the man gazing up at the constellations with a long, ancient smile, Samyeondaesa realized what was about to happen.

Perhaps,

[The story of the 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its storytelling.]

It would be his and his incarnation's favorite story.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 965 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (8)

—You really made that bet?

Anna Croft, having heard everything I said, looked as shocked as I had when I read the 'Apocalypse Prophecy'.

"Yes, well."

—We could have failed. If the constellations hadn't intervened in the bet, we could have been annihilated.

I looked at the 'golden dice' shining brightly in the air and said,

"I knew they'd intervene."

Before answering the summons, I told Jung Heewon about the bet in the 'Hall of Golden Dice'.

「"When the betting table opens, be sure to place a bet according to the 'betting conditions' I mentioned. I'll give you the D-coins in advance."」

The D-coins in the Ascension Hall are also used in higher-level scenarios. However, judging by the state of Valhalla Hall, the 'D-coins' in this area were already practically drying up.

"They absolutely need D-Coins to survive. There are only two ways to secure them in this area: win the game or—"

—Steal them from other incarnations or constellations.

I nodded. As expected, the clever Kim Anna had already figured out my intentions. Well, it was even stranger that Anna Croft, a former Las Vegas gambler, didn't know that.

「Skuld's 'Hall of Golden Dice' is one of Asgard's core corrupt events.」

All the bets in the hall were rigged by Skuld, the organizer, and a few 'whales'.

"With the blind money rolling in, there's no way they wouldn't act."

—Do you have any idea what you could do with that much D-Coins?

200,000 D-Coins. Enough to build a team of elite warriors, or even better.

In short, if those D-Coins were converted into summoning costs…

—You were definitely going to win the next match.

"Does that mean we're giving up this match?"

—You could be the next one to be resurrected.

"Then you're going to die."

—I'm not afraid of death anymore.

Do people who've experienced the same world hundreds of times all say similar things?

A gloomy story permeated her body, having endured hundreds of 'preliminary battles'.

And I knew what that story foreshadowed.

「Regression depression.」

Kim Anna suffered from 'regression depression'. If Yoo Joonghyuk had heard about it, he'd have been so shocked he'd have eaten dirt.

In any case, knowing the symptoms, I couldn't just ignore it, so I spoke.

"You're okay, but what about Selena Kim?"

'Regression depression' is a mental illness that corrodes the spirit of the incarnation, but there's one extreme solution: to place an even heavier burden on the regressor's heavy shoulders.

"If you give up so easily, what are the people who trusted you and participated in this competition going to do?"

This was the contradiction of 'regression depression'. The more the regressor reflected on their responsibilities and duties, the more they struggled to regain their sanity amidst the pain. Reclaim it.

Of course, the price would be worse the next time depression struck, but for now, there was no other way.

"Get your head together. We haven't lost yet."

Fortunately, it seemed to have worked, as Anna Croft's gaze began to brighten.

—Anyway… It's a shame you used the D-Coins like that. If it were those D-Coins…

"I also know how much 200,000 D-Coins are worth."

But here, I absolutely had to use them.

"If I was just going to win one game and move up, like you said, I wouldn't have used them either."

—What's that…

"Anyway, since we have time, let's do what we can. Let's…"

I slowly turned my gaze. Anna Croft also turned her head in my direction.

There.

There was Selena Kim, concentrating, making a specific hand gesture.

「Search Fox.」

Selena Kim's unique skill, which allows her to search the battlefield by summoning small fox guardian spirits.

I slowly opened my eyes and asked her, "Have you found the 'Bush'?"

Selena Kim nodded and relayed something to me through telepathy. For a moment, I felt the eyes of the battlefield turn towards me.

Anna Croft's telepathy came.

—Isn't that why you've been talking so much...

I gave a faint nod to the clever Anna Kim.

[The Constellation, 'Thunder-Eating bird', is wary of you.]

[The Constellation, 'General of Vanara', wants to uncover your scheme.]

[The Constellation, 'Founder of Humanity', is curious about what you're up to.]

They're pretending not to hear me, but... There's no way those sinister bastards wouldn't listen to me. An incarnation that's undeniably intimidating from the moment they meet is babbling such nonsense. What constellation wouldn't be interested?

—Was your goal from the beginning to buy time to find the 'bush'?

I deliberately opened my mouth to keep the constellations' attention on me. That way, Selena Kim's search foxes could be active.

「The missing bush. A 'Disaster-level Fear' that's said to randomly appear during every match. The incarnations who go missing through this bush have never returned to the stadium or the 'Valhalla Hall'.」

I had just received information about the various bushes hidden in this area from the 'Unchanging One'.

I briefly glanced over the bushes' appearance conditions and then slowly turned around.

There were the incarnations of our team, still trembling in fear.

Overwhelmed by the constellations' aura, the incarnations were frozen in place, unable to fight or flee. I stared at them silently, opening my mouth.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite LV.???' activated!]

"Everyone."

I felt everyone's gaze focused on me.

"I won't ask you to fight with me."

With the current level of [Incite], I could temporarily awaken the constellations from their fear.

"This is a battle with no clear chance of winning, so why risk your life fighting?"

Regardless of how they got here, the fact that they've reached Scenario 85 means they're among the elite in their region.

These incarnations have accumulated a fair amount of stories and have a certain understanding of the mechanics of this 'Star Stream'. They don't need complicated words of encouragement.

"Run. It's not shameful, so run until the very end. That's the last fight you can have on this damned battlefield."

The words I delivered with [Incite] were just empty, meaningless words anyone could say. Words I wouldn't have even bothered to utter.

"Survive, please."

Even so, the reason I opened my mouth to speak was simple.

「For some, even the courage to run is a luxury.」

Words telling them not to give up. Words telling them to live. Words that could be spoken purely for the sake of someone's survival, in a world filled with spectacle and mockery.

"Follow me, everyone! I know where the bushes are!"

Selena Kim exchanged glances with me and began to run, and one of the previously hesitant incarnations began to chase after her.

"Uuugh!"

"I've been trying to die here all this time—"

"Die only! I won't die!"

As if trying to give meaning to my empty cheers, the incarnations began to run away, screaming desperately.

However, the unfortunate truth was this:

[The constellation, 'Thunder-Eating bird', laughs derisively.]

This <Star Stream> was particularly cruel to the desperate struggles of the incarnations.

[I never said I'd let them go, though.]

A bolt of lightning struck from the air, and the Thunderbird's lightning struck right in front of Selena Kim's nose.

"Kwaaaaaaa!"

The incarnations running ahead screamed and fell to the ground.

The reason the constellations refused to let us go was clear. They were holding on, not killing us, because of the stakes in the 'bet'.

The reason they were holding us back now was probably to save them the trouble of searching for us, who had been scattered.

I briefly held back the dark clouds created by the Thunderbird. I looked at him and walked towards him.

"Newbies need to be treated warmly. Do you think your game will work properly if all the newbies quit? Oh, you didn't read that far?"

[Huh?]

"『Even a novice can master the game in a week』."

[How did you get that item...?]

I took a quick breath, then circulated the story in my heart strongly.

「'Demon King of Salvation' mode is activated.」

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', begins its storytelling!]

Along with the dazzling story that enveloped my entire body, [Way of the Wind] took hold at my feet. I soared into the air, overlaying [Baekcheongganggi] on my 'Unbreakable Faith'. I swung my sword towards the sky, and a surge of electricity struck the dark clouds in the sky. The dark clouds, crushed by my attack, instantly disintegrated.

[Go.]

The incarnations, hastily regaining their senses at my mantra, began to run again. Perhaps because they were concerned about me. The constellations didn't rush to chase the incarnations.

Instead, on the battlefield. They were curious about my display of aura.

[As expected, he's got a hidden plan.]

Unlike in 'New Murim District', the constellations didn't seem overly flustered despite my aura.

[Didn't I say so?]

[It seems he's sponsored by some small or medium-sized constellation.]

The 'Demon King of Salvation' mode radiates aura comparable to that of a late-stage narrative-grade.

But over there, there were three constellations that reached the late-stage narrative-grade.

Even the rest of the team were at least mid-stage narrative-grade, so it seemed they wouldn't lose their composure.

[I don't know which one, but it wouldn't be bad for entertainment.]

The constellations each began to radiate aura, as if ready to easily trample on me.

[The Constellation, 'Thunder-Eating bird', releases its aura!]

[The Constellation, 'General of Vanara', releases its aura!]

[The Constellation, 'Founder of Humanity', releases its aura!]

Anna Croft hurriedly intervened in the heated atmosphere of the battlefield.

"Constellations! Everyone, please stop! Have you forgotten that there's a wager at stake?"

The 'General of Banaras' responded with a sarcastic remark.

[The wager was 'that the match wouldn't end until the first prophecy was fulfilled'. The match wouldn't end just because one of them was killed.]

Watching the approaching constellations, I pulled Anna Croft back.

Anna Croft spoke, seemingly frustrated with the situation.

—Why on earth is this happening?

Did I do something wrong? With all the incarnations fleeing, we can't even have a final showdown.

"It's right to save at least one more person, Miss Kim Anna. You should go too."

—No.

"I don't need your help. You don't even know the future, so even if you stay by my side, it's useless."

In the thick silence, the pain she felt was palpable. But right now, there was no time to dwell on it.

"Help Selena Kim. You know this is her 'first match'."

"It's not just the constellations that are at risk on the battlefield. Are you just going to let them die like this?"

While lacking in strength and skill, no player has gained more experience in this 'outpost' than Anna Croft. Just having her with them will greatly increase the survival chances of Selena Kim and the Incarnations.

[A new story is sprouting within incarnation 'Anna Croft'!]

If she can successfully complete this 'outpost', she will receive compensation for her long suffering.

So—

"You haven't forgotten your plan, have you? Hide well and gather the 'prophecies'. That's the only way we can win."

At least she can't die here.

"Don't worry about me. You know who I am. I'm the Evil Sophist, the One Who Deceived the Stars…"

—You're not Cheon Inho, are you?

I never expected her to say that.

That's right. Now, I wasn't 'Cheon Inho' to her. I wasn't the 'Evil Sophist' or 'the One Who Deceived the Stars'.

—Mr. Kim End-nim.

She called me by a name that only meant something to me.

—If you say that, then there must be a reason. I guess I'll have to listen to you again, helpless and stupid.

"It's nice to hear that. Have I gained some trust now?"

—I don't trust you. I just…

With the rustle of her clothes, I felt Anna Croft turn away. She had finally made up her mind.

—I'm just trusting your 'bet'.

Hearing her footsteps retreat, I let out a light sigh.

—The person I know, the one who puts their life on the line, would have no reason to make such a risky bet.

It seems I couldn't fool her, even if I didn't know about others.

I looked up at the small golden dice that had been floating above my head for a while. This small dice was a symbol that only appeared to those who participated in the bets of the 'Hall of Golden Dice'.

[Could it be, that guy... made a bet?]

Several of the constellations frowned, as if they had belatedly noticed the symbol.

A small golden dice was also floating above their heads.

[Hahahahaha! Could it be that someone had placed a coin on the Prophet's team? Is that right?]

"But."

[You're crazy. You don't really think they'll win, do you?]

"Are there people who bet money thinking they'll lose?"

[What nonsense are you talking about? Do you really believe you can collect all the prophecies?]

"Oh, actually, that's a lie."

[You're currently participating in a bet at the 'Hall of Golden Dice'.]

[You bet on Team 'Zarathustra'.]

"Actually, I can win even without collecting prophecies."

[You placed an additional bet on 'End of match before the first prophecy appears!']

The constellations, with bitter smiles on their faces, turned to each other and said.

[You're in good spirits. How much did you bet? 1,000 D-coins.]

[Still, you seem like a good player. You must have bet around 10,000 D-coins.]

Listening to their advice, I recalled the words of the 'Mass Production Manufacturer'.

「"Coins are truly fascinating, aren't they? They're just numbers, but depending on the number of coins, the constellations can mock someone, be jealous of someone, or even show their greed."」

[No, he might have bet as much as 100,000 D-Coins.]

The 'General of Banara' bared his teeth and thrust his club at me.

[No matter how much you bet, the outcome of this bet won't change.]

"You think so?"

That was when the constellations' expressions changed.

[Wait! Wait. Just now…]

I could tell even without activating [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]. They were probably hearing something unusual right now.

[Someone bet on that team.]

[What? Some crazy guy—]

[How much did he bet?]

The voice of the Mass-Production Maker overlapped their expressions, which were changing in real time.

「"The real fun comes when the amount of those coins gets really large."」

Some amounts elicit ridicule, some envy, and some greed.

And some—

[That's, like, impossible! No matter how crazy—]

"Why are you all doing that?"

The mere existence of it inspires a kind of awe.

The constellations began to back away, as if they could see the numbers floating above my head.

I grinned at them.

[Your stake for this bet is 10,000,000 D-Coins.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 966 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (9)

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Skuld was the first to realize the odds were stacked against her.

"How much?"

Looking at the number that appeared before her eyes, Skuld asked like an idiot. But no one could answer her question. Even the employees running the 'Golden Dice Hall' had never seen such a number before.

—10 million D-Coins.

Someone muttered in a trembling voice.

[Not even the grand prize... Is this really the amount one person bets?]

The 'Valhalla Hall' opened, and wagers of all sizes were made. Some were so large that they drew gasps from the constellations. Prominent constellations fought fiercely, and the defeated constellations were scattered into the legends of the battlefield. Among them were battles waged by mythical constellations, and even legendary incarnations now elevated to the 'main battlefield'. Skuld looked at the all-time prize money rankings recorded on the stone tablet in the 'Hall of Golden Dice'.

—5th place in all-time total prize money.

The battle between Feihu, the incarnation of the Emperor, and Ranbir Khan, the incarnation of Papyrus. And the constellations of the Small and Medium Constellation Alliance.

Skuld, too, vividly remembered the atmosphere of the time. The participation of the representative incarnations of the Emperor and Papyrus, creating a truly spectacular spectacle, came to mind.

—Total prize money of 8.78 million D Coins.

Yet, even in such a match, the total prize money was only 8.78 million D Coins.

Skuld looked at the rankings even higher.

—4th place in all-time total prize money.

The fierce battle between the incarnations of Archangel Jophiel and the incarnations of the Great Heavenly King against the constellations of Papyrus. The unexpected rookies delivered a remarkable performance, and the match left no one in doubt until the very end.

—Total prize pool: 9.92 million D Coins.

Even that bet didn't exceed 10 million D Coins.

Just looking at this, you could tell just how enormous the stakes were.

Not even the total prize pool, just a single bet of 10 million D Coins.

She could only remember one match of that scale.

—Highest prize pool of all time

It was a match between Mitra, the 'Master of December 25th' of <Vida>, and '■■■'—the unmentionable 'Master of the Erased Margin'.

—35,973,200 D Coins

That was the match with the largest amount of D Coins ever wagered.

—Highest single bet: 9 million D Coins.

But even in that match, 10 million D Coins had never been wagered at once. To begin with, the gigantic castle was a bet that couldn't be made without this kind of courage.

[There must be something wrong. At this point, no whale can secure 10 million D-Coins.]

No whale currently in the hall could wager 10 million D-Coins at once. Those that were still promising had departed for the 'main battlefield'. For greater achievements, to carry out the 'real scenario' in that distant aspiration, to reach the final goal.

The final record—a truly southern story. Of course, if it succeeds, it will.

'Could it be an unknown myth-grade constellation?'

Skuld thought of the 'special warrior' who had previously bet 200,000 D-Coins.

But even if that special warrior had the support of a myth-grade constellation, those myth-grade constellations wouldn't possess such an absurd amount of D-Coins. That's understandable. Ten million D-Coins, when exchanged, could affect the entire <Star Stream>.

Skuld pondered for a moment, then a certain constellation's epithet suddenly came to mind.

[Perhaps the 'Mass-Production Manufacturer'?]

That old man was the only constellation that could wield such economic power alone.

But the other employees quickly shook their heads.

[I sent him a message, and he said he only built the stadium and wasn't interested in the hall's bets.]

[So, who exactly is he?]

[I heard there's a planet with a recent 'Orbital Elevator' problem. Could someone have swiped the D-Coins from the Ascension Zone?]

[There's no way an Ascension Zone still has that much D-Coins—]

Skuld paused. There was only one Ascension Zone where a massive amount of D-Coins could still be mined:

'New Murim District'.

A staggering amount of D-Coins lay dormant in the 'New Murim District', but the constellations rarely touched it. This was because the 'Fear Realm', the border area of the 'New Murim District' was connected to the dimension of the Outer Gods.

The story of the Olympus fleet recklessly entering the Fear Realm and suffering massive damage was so well-known that many high-ranking constellations avoided even the area's vicinity.

[I recently heard that a doomsday scenario had occurred in the 'New Murim District'.]

But what if some madman appeared, swept up all the D-Coins in the district, and entered 'Valhalla Hall'?

[Someone placed a bet on ...!]

[Someone placed a bet on ...!]

…

The betting amount increased in real time.

It should have been fun, but Skuld couldn't shake the feeling of unease.

[The results of betting on Team 'Zarathustra' are increasing!]

The hall was now in a frenzy. Some constellations, having learned that someone had bet 10 million D-Coins on 'Zarathustra', began a test bet.

The amount wasn't large, and 'Veda' still had an overwhelming number of bets, but the problem was what if something unexpected happened?

[The total prize pool is approaching the all-time ranking!]

Skuld spoke, her voice rising.

[Has the bettor's identity been verified yet?]

[This is a pseudonymous bet, so verification is not possible. However, there's a rumor that one of the participants in the match is the bettor.]

[We're verifying the identities of all participants!]

「What if this whole situation was planned by someone?」

What if those 200,000 D-Coins, what if the entire development up until now, was simply a ploy to attract the constellations of the hall?

The recorders, having smelled the rumor somewhere, began scribbling ominous records.

「What if the Prophet's team, 'Zarathustra', wins here?」

The likelihood of that happening was slim.

[Due to excessive D-Coin betting, an unusual atmosphere began to flow through 'Valhalla Hall'.]

All the constellations of Team 'Vedas' were veterans.

But even so, what if something like that really happened?

「Perhaps the final days of 'Valhalla Hall' could arrive.」

Skuld wiped the cold sweat from her forehead and asked.

[What happened with the whale gathering?]

[Some whales have already participated in the bet. The rest have informed us they will wait and see.]

The opponent had a wealth of 10 million D-Coins. A mediocre whale was no match for him.

[Send a message to the 'chairman' of the hall.]

Skuld, staring silently at the screen, concluded her speech.

[It seems like a mythical figure will have to step forward.]

---

10 million D-Coins.

The 'Thunderbird', having noticed my bet, let out a shriek.

[That can't be true. Such a bet is impossible!]

It's surprising. None of them could possibly bet that amount.

Perhaps a narrative-grade constellation hiding its power like the 'Mass-Produced Manufacturer' would be understandable.

[The Constellation, 'Ancestor of Humanity', tells you not to panic.]

Meanwhile, there was a constellation that maintained its composure. Indeed, it seemed not all constellations were overwhelmed by the 'numbers' of the coins.

[If someone is willing to bet 10 million D-Coins on this game, it must be one of two things. Either they're a wealthy constellation that can easily afford to bet that much, or they're a fool who's betting their entire fortune on a bad gamble.]

Manu continued speaking with a calm gaze, as if analyzing me.

[No matter how I look at it, he doesn't seem that wealthy. He's quite wealthy, but there are plenty of constellations around here with similar ranks.]

The constellations, who had been caught off guard by Manu's words, quickly regained their composure.

[If we kill him here and now, we can take his D-Coins. If that happens…]

Manu trailed off, but I could still read the aftermath: all the constellations there had vanished.

[You might become a key player in the 'main battlefield'.]

Acquiring a massive amount of D-Coins won't instantly elevate you to 'mythical' status.

But you'll at least gain a comparable rank. Then, they probably believe, they might become key players in the 'main battlefield'.

[Why are you laughing?]

"If you were meant to go to the 'main battlefield', you would have gone long ago."

I glanced at the constellations in front of me and said.

The qualifications for the 'Main Battle' are simple.

「Win at least one game of the 'Outpost'.」

None of the constellations before me now met this qualification.

The constellations earned the right to participate in the 'Main Battle' long ago, and voluntarily refused to participate.

"I understand why you remain here, repeating the game."

They are not like Yoo Joonghyuk or Anna Croft, who were forced to repeat the same world.

So to speak, they were 'voluntary regressors'.

Those who remain in the Outpost forever, refusing to advance to the next scenario.

「These are the ones who fear death.」

The constellations, standing on the brink of 'Ragnarok', collapsed in their seats, fearing they would lose all the stories they had accumulated.

"You are not worthy to see the ■■ of the world."

Like the wanderers who waited for someone to finish the main scenario, these are cowards who long for the desperate battle of the 'Main Battle' to end quickly. That was it.

[There's nothing more to hear.]

Manu, his expression hardened coldly, shouted, aiming his spear.

[Kill them!]

With those words, the constellations moved. Manu's spear flew, and Garuda's thunder rained down.

I barely managed to dodge the spear and deflect the thunder, but this time Hanuman's massive club flew towards my back. I barely managed to activate [Way of the Wind], but it only grazed the story's body and sent it flying.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is activating!]

I thought, enduring the pain.

In a sense, Manu was right. In reality, my chances of winning against them weren't great.

「In order to earn 10 million D Coins, I vomited out all the D Coins I had absorbed into stories.」

This was insane enough, but there was an even more serious problem.

「In exchange for exchanging the coins, the power of the 'King of Fear' can't be unleashed here.」

What raised me to a mythical status was the World Tree of the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' and the story of the 'King of Fear'. However, because I had extracted a large amount of D-Coins from my stories, the only power I could use right now was the 'Demon King of Salvation' mode.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', continues its storytelling.]

To make matters worse, this mode would last for another ten minutes.

Seeing that I couldn't easily seize a counterattack, the constellations' expressions began to soften.

[He was nothing special, after all.]

[I'll take care of him quickly and go capture the others!]

The golden dice in the air began to spin furiously, watching me cornered in a one-sided defensive position.

[The betting amount for this bet is increasing!]

While checking the betting amount updated in real time, I continued to fend off the constellations' attacks. Even with [All-Personification] activated, the attacks from the constellations at the late narrative-grade were threatening.

Narrative blasts erupted from my forearms and thighs.

[All the constellations in Valhalla Hall are watching this match.]

Amidst the pouring gazes, the constellations' faces erupted in sinister smiles.

Judging by the ceaseless flash of coin symbols, it seemed a barrage of support was underway, something I was unaware of.

The next moment, a massive saga began to gather attention around Manu's opera.

[The Constellation, 'Progenitor of Humanity', has used the 'Steady Kill' item!]

Alarm bells rang in my head.

[Steady Kill.]

A one-time cost item obtained from the 'Outpost'.

I had heard of this item's effects through the 'Unchanging One'.

「A single strike guarantees a doubled power hit against a target in the Silver Area.」

This attack cannot be dodged or deflected.

I turned and began to flee. With all my might, I activated [Way of the Wind], relentlessly searching the desolate grassland.

「I have to find it.」

I heard the sound of Manu's spear being fired. The downside of the One-Point Kill is that its speed decreases as its power increases.

「According to Selena Kim, the coordinates where the target bush is hidden are within fifty meters of here—」

The bush wasn't easily visible. It was only natural, since I was new to this battlefield.

Manu's spear was within striking distance. I smiled wryly and turned my back to block it.

And at that very moment...

"I knew this would happen."

Someone grabbed my waist tightly. Here it is.

I was thrown to the ground, still clutched by my waist. Then, to my surprise, the floor suddenly caved in, and I felt my body being sucked into another dimension.

[Entering the 'Bush'.]

Looking for the 'bush'-like structure was a mistake. Surprisingly, this 'bush' existed as a trap beneath the floor.

Thanks to the bush's special effects, Manu's spear narrowly grazed my back and bounced out of the space.

"I'm in your debt. Thank you."

I turned to my rescuer. There, Anna Kim, who I'd assumed had gone to help Selena Kim, was glaring at me with angry eyes.

"You said you believed my bet, didn't you?"

"I said I believed your bet, not you. Why on earth did you do this?"

Kim Anna examined the wound on my back, where Manu's spear had grazed, then cut her palm and squeezed the blood out. Her special trait, the power of the 'Elixir Maker', manifested, and my wound began to heal quickly.

"Thank you."

"There's no need for gratitude. You're going to die soon anyway."

"Why are you treating me when I'm going to die anyway?"

Kim Anna couldn't answer.

I spoke for her.

"Even if we know the world's destruction is certain, we still have to save those who are dying today, don't we?"

"…"

"Yoo Joonghyuk was like that too."

Kim Anna's face brightened for a moment.

"Is the Supreme King coming to help?"

"It's a good thing he's here, since you're here."

Kim Anna's expression darkened again. I smiled comfortingly and said,

"Don't worry. I'm here."

"What on earth were you thinking when you did something like this?"

It's understandable, even for our Kim Anna. I suddenly barged into the match, provoked the constellations, forced the incarnations to evacuate, and even made a strange bet, drawing the attention of Valhalla Hall.

"I want to end the regression."

"Huh?"

"You know that, right? If you win this match, your regression will end, but eventually, someone will fill your void."

Some regressions never end.

Because this world wants a regression.

"So, to end this game properly—"

[The stakes on this bet are rising!]

"The only way to make those who want this game quit the game themselves."

[The stakes on this bet are rising!]

[The stakes on this bet have finally broken the all-time rankings of the 'Hall of Golden Dice'!]

Even in the 'Valhalla Hall', it's not easy to raise this amount of money. Many constellations must have staked their entire fortunes on this match.

"Now they'll have to return to 'Scenarios'."

However, Kim Anna, whose thoughts were only negative after a long regression, still looked unconvinced.

"Even if your plan is correct, you need to win this match to make it happen. That too—"

"Before the first prophecy appeared."

Then I sensed the presence of constellations from above. The ones who had hesitated at my entrance into the bushes had finally rushed in to finish us off.

But I wasn't fazed at all. Because this fight was only just beginning.

"No. It was impossible. Unless even the Supreme King comes…"

"Kim Anna-ssi."

I took a slow breath. Then I felt a story stir deep within me.

"As I said before, Yoo Joonghyuk won't come. Because—"

All conditions are met.

"There's no need."

Watching the constellations rushing towards me, I checked the elements necessary for this stage.

「Thunder-eating bird.」

「General of Banara.」

「Progenitor of humanity.」

「Thick bush.」

「Battlefield of myth.」

The ground beneath my feet rippled. This battlefield, which had absorbed countless fragments of Kim Dokja, seemed to be reading and reacting to the stories embedded within me.

「Giant story.」

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', responds to your will.]

[Giant story, 'Spring of the Demon World', begins its storytelling!]

The pages of [Bookmark] began to turn in my mind.

The story I had read, and every Kim Dokja in this land had read.

Along with the rippling scenery, the stage we had read was reenacted before my eyes. A story I, the original Kim Dokja, would never have been able to recreate.

But now, having reached myth-grade, it was different.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

[Your incite affects the reading comprehension of 'Bookmark'!]

"I."

Facing the dazzling fury of the constellations, I inserted the final piece needed for this 'stage'.

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk, who participated in the 1,864th 'Demon King Selection Tournament'."

['Staging' begins!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 967 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (10)

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I felt the pages of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 turning before my eyes.

"This story...?"

Anna Croft's eyes widened. Even she, who can't use [Future Sight], will see this story.

Spring in the Demon World. A giant story that occupies the Introduction part of Kim Dokja's 'Introduction, Development, Turn, and Conclusion'.

Originally, to fully utilize this story on stage, I needed the help of the members of <Kim Dokja Company>.

[The probable conditions for staging a 'Giant Story' are not sufficient!]

But that's only when unfolding the entire stage, and what I needed was a 'part of the stage'.

[You fool. Did you think we wouldn't find you if you hid in the bushes?]

Just then, the constellations that had entered the bushes spotted me. Led by Garuda, the 'Thunder-Eating Bird', Hanuman, the 'General of Banaras', Manu, the 'Progenitor of Humanity', and the nine constellations lined up behind them. They seemed determined to defeat me within this bushes.

[The effect of 'Bush' is activated!]

[The bushes in question are a 'Chaos Bush'.]

Anna Croft, having confirmed the name of the bush, calmly spoke.

"Kim Dokja. The distinctive feature of this bush is its large rock."

As expected of a returning expert in skirmishes, she had a precise grasp of the bush's properties.

"Events occurring within this bush are not observable from the outside."

I nodded.

In fact, I had also heard of the effect of the bush through the 'Unchangeable One'.

「Chaos Bush. Events occurring within this bush are free from all external observation, including from the audience.」

In other words, no matter what happens within this bush, no one outside will know.

"There must be another effect besides that, right?"

"Did you know?"

Anna asked, surprised.

Actually, the second effect didn't require any explanation.

[The effect of 'Chaos Bush' temporarily weakens the binding force of probability!]

Because the effect was already activating right before my eyes.

[The Giant Story, 'Samundra Manthan', begins its storytelling!]

The Giant Story, 「Samundra Manthan」[1].

One of the creation myths representing <Vedas> was awakening before my eyes.

[NOTE 1]

[The players of Team 'Vedas' are blessed by the constellation, 'King of Thunder'!]

The blessing of Indra, the King of Thunder.

If the strongest Lokaphala had lent his strength to the 'Giant Story', then <Vedas> must have made a good bet on this one.

[Ooooooooooo!]

Garuda, Hanuman, Manu, and other constellations screamed in joy. With a pounding in my head, <Vedas>'s giant story began to unfold.

「Understanding is as meaningless as counting the foam on a milky sea.」

If I hadn't attained this level, I would have lost my mind just witnessing that scene.

「Only those gods who participate in the great 'Samundra Manthan' will attain eternity.」

A gentle sensation spread throughout the subspace, and soon the area was transformed into a vast, unseen world. It transformed into a sea of milk. A massive shaft then rose above the sea, and the ocean began to swirl violently.

「One of the creation myths of Vedas—the Samundra Manthan.」

The ritual created by the Vedas' gods to fight the Asuras in the past—the Samundra Manthan.

Originally, it was a much larger creation myth, but perhaps they only recreated certain passages to fit this subspace.

[Ohhhhh! Ultimate wisdom! Ancient intelligence! Great will!]

The white light emanating from the sea was being absorbed into the bodies of the constellations.

Indeed, that light was the very core of this giant story.

The elixir of immortality, realized through the Samundra Manthan—'Amrita'.

The constellations, temporarily empowered by Amrita, began to unleash a merciless blast.

The three constellations, which had been at the late stage of narrative-grade, had grown to the point of rivaling the representative constellation of Vedas, 'Lokapala', and the other

constellations, too. It began to radiate a level of power that reached the level of the late-game legends.

And that wasn't all.

[Ooooooooooo!]

The already large incarnations of the gods had grown even larger than before. They were so large that it was almost believable if someone told me they were their true forms.

I measured the power of the constellations and said,

"It seems our arrival here isn't a coincidence."

As soon as we entered this thicket, the giant legends of Vedas moved. Furthermore, the structure of this thicket seemed perfectly suited to concealing the events of the skirmish.

I squinted, and a record appeared in the air with a light spark.

「Members of Team 'Zarathustra' will inevitably enter the 'Chaos Bush'.」

As expected. It seemed Vedas had written a [Fate] on the Recorders of Fear in advance.

Given this situation, it wouldn't have been surprising if the first bush Anna Croft and I entered was the 'Chaos Bush'.

The ranks of the gods Anna Croft, having confirmed this, raised her voice in a tense tone.

"We need to get out of the bush immediately."

But the entrance to the bush was completely blocked by the constellations.

Anna Croft, biting her lip, summoned all her magical power and spoke.

"I'll try to buy some time, and in the meantime—"

"If you're still going to rant like that, just close your eyes and raise your hands in the corner."

"Huh?"

"Or maybe you should eat dirt."

"What—"

One of the effects of the 'Chaos Bush' was to weaken the binding force of probability. If that were the case, it wasn't entirely unfavorable to me.

Tsutsutsutsu.

The story flowing through my body took on an even more powerful force.

"In case you forgot, there's a giant story here too."

[The giant story, 'Spring of the Demon World', is imbued on your right arm.]

In terms of sheer scale, 'Spring of the Demon World' wasn't quite up to par to 'Samundra Manthan'.

Anna Croft, realizing this, spoke again.

"With a story of that magnitude—"

"The 'Giant Story' over there is powerful, but it's not entirely theirs."

Now it was time to demonstrate the fruits of my training with Han Sooyoung in the 1,863rd round.

"Don't worry. I've read this story so many times I'm sick of it."

「"If you're going to write a new story, you have to take responsibility for the ones you've already written."」

Hearing Han Sooyoung's voice in my head, I considered the stories I'd read.

As if unable to contain their increased power, the constellations in the front row began to rush towards me.

[Ooooooooo!]

Concentrating the 'Giant Story' on my right arm, I recalled the conditions for staging.

Characters, story, location.

The characters on stage were fulfilled by the constellations and my [Incite], and the story was no different. The location, while imperfect, was also a 'Battlefield of Myths'. It could be fulfilled with a stage similar to a 'preliminary battle'.

[The requirements for 'Staging' have been partially met!]

['Staging' is in progress!]

However, this alone wasn't enough to create a 'stage' that could defeat the constellations.

More than anything, I was currently imitating Yoo Joonghyuk with [Incite].

I needed something to supplement the lack of stage presence.

Whoosh.

At that moment, the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' wrapped around my arm in the form of a bracelet reacted.

I grinned and looked at it.

Yes, it's finally your time to act.

It's been a long time since I acquired this 'Thought'. Until now, I hadn't been able to utilize it properly, but from now on, it would be different.

「"There's a limit to how much I can teach you anyway."」

During the 1,863rd round's training session, Han Sooyoung was preoccupied with finding a way for me to grow in the shortest possible time.

「"The techniques I taught you here will inevitably be subject to probability constraints. Even if you were to learn it, it'd probably only be usable in the final scenario. But if you were to give it an item from here, it would also be subject to probability constraints. So, I thought…"」

The form of 'Thought', which had received my story, was changing in real time.

「"What if I taught it all the relics I possess?"」

Thus, during the 1,863rd round, Han Sooyoung and I taught 'Thought' the mimicry forms of countless items.

Of course, contrary to Han Sooyoung's expectations, this method didn't completely avoid probability constraints.

Perhaps due to excessive mimicry learning, 'Thought' was severely bound by probability immediately after the world line transition.

However, here, where probability constraints were weakened, it was a different story.

[The mimicry proficiency of 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' has increased explosively!]

[The mimicry learning of the item 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' has been completely completed.]

"Black Heavenly Sword."

The moment I opened my mouth, Thoughts transformed into a pitch-black sword.

Episode 1,864: Yoo Joonghyuk's exclusive weapon—Black Heavenly Sword.

[The reproducibility of 'Staging' has greatly increased!]

The entire landscape began to ripple and change. The place that had been the bush of the 'Outpost' had transformed into the 'Battlefield of Myths'.

But the transformation was so natural that the constellations rushing toward me hadn't yet noticed it.

Feeling the immense rumbling within my heart, I gripped the hilt of the 'Black Heavenly Sword'.

The battle would be decided in a single moment. In that single moment, all the decisive words would be uttered.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Now I know. No matter how brilliant my [Incite] skills are, I can never become someone else.

「"No matter how elegant a lie, a lie is still a lie."」

Sometimes, lies reveal what truth is. It's only permitted to those who know. To tell a well-crafted lie, you must understand the truth just as well.

「"There's no need to be afraid. The world doesn't really care what 'reality' is anyway."」

Anna Croft, who had been blankly watching me from the side, let out a short groan and asked.

"How—"

I looked at her. Our eyes met, and Anna Croft's shoulders trembled violently. She knew I wasn't Yoo Joonghyuk. And yet, at this moment, she was overwhelmed by the lie that deceived even her own senses.

"Supreme King?"

I activated [Vermilion Divine Treasure] at the rushing constellations. With the effects of [Incite] and [Bookmark], Yoo Joonghyuk's traits burned through my mind.

[Exclusive trait, 'Ruler of Entertainment, activates!]

One of Yoo Joonghyuk's most powerful traits from the 1,864th round.

「As long as this stage is a 'game', Yoo Joonghyuk becomes closer to God than any other constellation in this world.」

Manu, the Progenitor of Humanity, felt a strange sensation.

He aimed his spear at me, shouting,

[Wait! Stop! That guy, something—]

But by the time his spear reached me, I was already gone.

A panicked Manu looked around frantically and shouted,

[Where! Where on earth—]

And then thunder rumbled through the sky.

「From the distant sky, a bird fell, its neck impaled by a giant sword.」

"Kyaaaaak", the Garuda in the sky screamed.

[What—]

Manu shouted, his eyes wide, and Hanuman roared and swung his club. But it was no use.

「The moment the panicked 'General of Banara' retreated, a flash of light flashed through the dirt on the ground.」

Because, unknown to them, this entire story had already been completed.

[How could such a history—]

Manu let out a gasp of horror as he watched Hanuman's head be severed in an instant.

I looked at Manu and the constellations of Vedas, and said,

[I guess Agni hasn't heard my story yet.]

At the mention of Agni, Manu's face began to turn pale. Something seemed to be belatedly dawning on him.

[W-Wouldn't it be? You...?]

As I approached the stars, Manu and the other constellations began frantically searching for an escape route.

[Tell the mythical constellations of 'Ragnarok'.]

But unfortunately, I was the one standing in front of that escape route.

「At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk looked as if he understood everything about this 'game'.」

The fully embodied 'Giant Story' began to speak through my body. The Supreme King, now possessing a mythical status, declared to the constellations of Vedas:

[The fear you forgot has returned to the Star Stream.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: The Samudra Manthana (Sanskrit: समुद्रमन्थन, lit. 'churning of the ocean') is a major episode in Hinduism that is elaborated in the Vishnu Purana, a major text of Hinduism. The Samudra Manthana explains the origin of the elixir of eternal life, amrita.

# 968 Episode 57 Twilight of the Gods (11)

Skuld watched the stadium, biting her fingernails.

[What the hell is going on? Why isn't anyone coming out?]

A considerable amount of time had passed since the constellations on Vedas' side entered the thicket. Judging by the inability to observe the interior from the audience, the bush they entered was a 'Chaos Bush'.

「The appearance of the Chaos Bush must mean that Vedas has inserted probability.」

If Vedas had stepped in, the conversation with the recorders would have been over, and [Fate] would have been rigged without a hitch. Furthermore, Skuld had already made a separate announcement to the chairman, so there was absolutely no way Team Vedas would lose.

[The current total wager from Veda bettors is 8,754,300 D-coins.]

The total D-coins wagered by Vedas in this match alone exceeded 8 million. Even from the perspective of the Great Nebula, this was a battle they absolutely could not afford to lose, so there was no chance of an unfortunate incident. At this point, not only [Fate] but even the grand narratives of Vedas would have been used.

Skuld was well aware of this fact. That's why she couldn't quite understand her own anxiety.

[The constellation, 'Observer of the Indelible Traces', warns you.]

The Observer of the Indelible Traces.

She was Urd, Skuld's sister and observer of the past. It had been a while since Urd had interfered in the betting table.

[Urd, what's going on?]

Consultation had recently been lost with Verdandi, who governed the present, so hearing from her sister was a welcome change.

[Did you see something?]

But Urd didn't respond.

And a moment later, a strange message came from the air.

[The constellation, 'Observer of Indelible Traces', is astonished!]

[The constellation, 'Observer of Indelible Traces', is astonished!]

[The constellation, 'Observer of Indelible Traces', is astonished!]

With a burst of sparks, Urd's presence vanished.

[Urd?]

A vain mantra rang out, but Urd's reply remained unanswered.

Skuld instinctively knew.

'Something has happened to Urd.'

But who could harm her, the one who controls fate?

A spark of probability radiated from the stadium once again, and Skuld stared blankly at the scene.

The image reflected only the exterior of a sinister bush. Yet, as she gazed at it, Skuld felt increasingly strange.

She knew the principles of that bush, and she had a clear understanding of its inner workings. But why did that obvious bush feel so terrifying today?

Looking at the exit through the swaying bushes, Skuld felt as if a vast abyss was gaping open, ready to swallow her whole.

「If, what Urd saw—」

Since when? Even the constellations and incarnations in the bustling audience remained silent, their gaze fixed on the insignificant bush. As if they sensed a momentous event was about to unfold in the Valhalla Hall.

[The match has ended.]

[…has won the 1265th battle…]

The moment the match-ending message sounded, Skuld leaped to her feet. The moment she had been waiting for had finally arrived. However, perhaps due to the aftershock of probability raging through the arena, the winner confirmation message was not properly displayed.

[You crazy bastards, how much probability did they even use?]

If this much trouble was happening in Scenario 85, there would have been considerable bloodshed even in <Vedas>.

But with the chairman personally stepping in and the stakes coming in, it wasn't a loss for the giant nebula.

[The betting in the 'Golden Dice Hall' is over!]

The settlement, radiating such dazzling light, was the first since the 'Golden Dice Hall' opened. For a moment, the constellations throughout the hall gaped in awe at the radiance.

Excited cries of constellations echoed from all around, asking who won and what the profit ratios were.

And the next moment, the 'execution stand' opened in the center of the arena. The audience's expressions hardened as they saw the faces of the contestants being summoned one by one.

Skuld's shoulders also trembled.

[No.]

Someone spoke, and as if waiting, the 'Execution Squad' event began.

The first to speak was a giant bird.

[AAAAAAAAAAAAH!]

Along with Garuda's resentful screams, the system message, muffled by the aftershock, became clear.

[Team 'Zarathustra' has won the 1265th battle.]

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When I returned to 'Valhalla Hall' in a dazzling ray of light, I was greeted by a splendid waiting room.

[You were first in the 'Outpost.']

[The 'Hall of Golden Injections' has delivered you an urgent message.]

[The 'Hall of Golden Dice' apologizes for the temporary delay in settlement and requests a secret meeting.]

It seems this victory has caused quite a stir in 'Valhalla Hall'.

I rejected all the messages that piled up and then disabled [Incite].

['Deactivate 'Demon King of Salvation' mode.]

A powerful rebound briefly sent me into a state of dizziness. Perhaps the reason I felt somewhat more resilient was because my incarnation body had become somewhat stronger by the time I reached the 85th scenario.

「This was a tough fight.」

If my proficiency with [Incite] and [Bookmark] had been slightly lacking, and above all, if I hadn't finished learning the mimicry of 'Thoughts on Almost Everything', this would have been an unwinnable fight.

'Thought', now in its bracelet form, hummed, and I lightly tapped its main body.

"Well done."

If 'Thought' hadn't acquired the mimicry forms of 'Robin Hood's Strong Bow' and 'Black Heavenly Sword', the 'Demon King Selection Tournament' stage would have been an incomplete recreation.

[You've achieved an incredible feat!]

[Your match will be listed in the Battleground rankings.]

[You can check the list of matches in the Battleground rankings in the waiting room.]

[You've acquired a new story!]

And a new story.

[You've acquired the story, 'Slayer Beyond Records'!]

[This story is a 'Quasi-Mythical Tale'.]

A quasi-mythical tale, it will be absorbed by the 'Giant Story' within the public domain, but acquiring a quasi-mythical story in a single match was still a significant achievement.

By the way, have Anna Kim and Selena been summoned here yet?

I quickly scanned the messages and then surveyed the waiting room.

The winner's waiting room was a kind of reception room, a place for comfortable relaxation. A large, circular table sat in the center of the room, and on it were dishes that looked delicious at first glance.

「The Right Arm of the Kaizenix Ancestor」

「The Lungs of the 9th Circle Archmage」

「The Frontal Lobe of the Maddened Lich」

Of course, it was called food, but in reality, it was stories. They felt just like food from the Underworld, so I couldn't bring myself to eat them. But…

Whoosh.

'Thought' vibrated again.

"You want to eat?"

It was strange. 'Thought' had never wanted to consume stories before. Perhaps its eating habits had evolved as it acquired a massive amount of mimetic forms.

Whoosh.

"Understood."

Come to think of it, it used to make strange sounds like "Joba" and "Shijo"... Now that it was calmly complaining of hunger, it must have grown up. I felt both proud and regretful at the same time. As I brought some of the dishes from the living room near 'Thoughts,' part of the bracelet opened like a beak and immediately began crunching on the stories.

[The item, 'Thoughts of Almost Everything', consumes the 'Lungs of the 9th Circle of the Archmage'!]

From somewhere, I thought I could hear the pained gasp of the wizard.

Perhaps these stories, too, had fallen from the incarnations who died in the skirmish.

As I continued to feed it stories, contemplating this and that, other incarnations appeared in a flash of light.

"Huh—"

They must have been engaged in a battle with something, as all the incarnations were covered in dust.

"Uh, uh-huh?"

I could see the expressions of the incarnations changing in real time as they turned to each other, making strange noises.

The 'victory message' must have flashed before their eyes as well.

Finally, one of the incarnations, his eyes tearful, turned to me and asked: "Did we win?"

As I nodded, one of the incarnations screamed.

"Ahhhhh—!"

Some cried out, while others collapsed, sobbing.

I don't know what they endured before being summoned to the 'Outpost'.

I don't know if their cries were a sense of relief at being alive, or despair at the scenario's distant future. Since I don't know their sorrow, I can't console it.

"Anyone died?"

All I could do was confirm their names and add a few dry remarks.

It occurred to me that perhaps it wasn't just 'Thought' that had changed during the scenario.

Just as 'Thought' had become a boring item, perhaps I, too, had become a predictable person.

"Members of the winning team will automatically resurrect even if they die. So, there's no need to worry."

Where the voices came from, Anna Croft and Selena Kim were standing.

"You really did it, you."

After a brief reunion with the brightly smiling Selena Kim, I turned to Anna Croft. Even with the long-awaited victory of the 'Outpost' within sight, Anna Kim's expression didn't seem particularly bright.

[Exclusive trait, 'Understander of the Abyss', activated.]

She stood blankly, staring at the massive hologram screen installed in the reception room.

The screen showed scenes from the stadium and the execution ceremony that had just begun.

The constellations, long consumed by the deaths of the incarnations, were now making their 'final statements' to postpone their own.

[I, I cannot die here—]

There was no longer any dignity or nobility of the narrative-grade constellations. With expressions and voices no different from any other incarnation, they were screaming in despair.

[Myth-grade constellations! Are you watching? This is not right!]

The audience, which would normally have laughed and chattered at such losers, was silent this time. It had to be that way. The constellations in the audience were probably seeing their own futures through the scaffold.

[Just one more chance, just one more chance—]

And Anna Croft, finally finished with her long fight, was watching the stars' final demise.

The execution platform. The place she had stood hundreds of times. And finally, standing there, the constellations.

"Kim Anna-ssi."

Watching her back, I suddenly thought of Yoo Joonghyuk.

What had Yoo Joonghyuk been thinking, facing the end of all those scenarios?

"I feel strange."

Her long shadow swayed in the light of the drawing room.

"I thought standing here would be a relief."

It was the first time I'd heard Anna Croft's voice so candid.

"I thought I'd be truly happy."

Above the execution platform, the constellations, facing death, were emitting their final rays. Gazing at the starlit landscape, I nodded.

"Yes, I knew that."

Neither I nor Kim Anna-ssi knew how to explain this feeling.

What was certain was that, now that we were finally on par with the distant constellations, the landscape we saw had changed. Now we knew with certainty what stories those once brilliant stars were made of.

"What do we... see at the end of all this? Kim Dokja, do you know?"

"I don't know either."

All we could do was watch the insignificant stars extinguish one by one on the scaffold.

"Because we don't know that, we can't give up this story."

The giant blade swung, and the constellations began to be beheaded. Each time a constellation's light went out, the light in the drawing room flickered faintly. Perhaps it was my imagination? The shadows around me seemed to grow longer. I thought I heard a thump, thump, coming from somewhere. At first, I thought it was the constellations' heads being slit.

The sound repeated with frightening precision.

Only when I realized I was unconsciously overwhelmed by that brief echo did I realize what had happened.

「Someone was knocking on the drawing room door.」

I felt my entire body tense. The moment I slowly turned toward the door, Anna Croft, her expression hardened, grabbed my wrist.

"Kim Dokja, you must not open the door."

Her eyes, which had lost their strength during the skirmish, radiated a faint red light.

Perhaps, in that moment, something caught her [Future Sight].

"Right now, beyond that door—"

Hearing her trembling voice, I too sensed the presence beyond the door.

A presence distinctly different from any other constellation.

Having now reached myth-grade, I too could clearly see it.

"There is a myth-grade constellation."

The master of this 'Valhalla Hall' had come to us.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 969 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (1)

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There was another knock. I smiled faintly at Anna Croft, who was still looking at me with worried eyes.

"Don't worry. I told you I'm myth-grade, too."

"Now I'm not even sure if you're using [Incite] or not."

I stared at Anna Croft, who was smiling bitterly, for a moment before joining her in grabbing the doorknob.

"Opening."

「In the world of 'Ways of Survival', the owner of 'Valhalla Hall' changes every time.」

The owner of 'Valhalla Hall' was sometimes a forgotten mythical constellation from <Asgard>, and sometimes a constellation from another nebula. From my perspective, it didn't matter. After all, if a 'mythical constellation' truly came with hostility, there was no way to avoid it.

But at least the one who came this time knocked politely. That meant, at least, he wasn't here to fight me.

As I opened the door, a dazzling light enveloped me. For a moment, I felt as if the universe itself was blooming and fading before my eyes.

「A myth was before my eyes.」

I don't know much about the beginning and end of the universe. However, there must have been a moment when the primordial light was born. There must have been a moment when it illuminated the universe and created the landscape. Some stars will long for that light, yearn for it, and yearn endlessly. After so much yearning and yearning, some stars will embrace that light. Perhaps we may reach an interpretation of this.

[This is my first time seeing this, Demon King of Salvation.]

What I now see is an interpretation of such light. A beautiful and splendid interpretation. To reach that interpretation, that constellation must have read and reread a single story for eons. And thus, finally, it has reached that primordial fragment.

[Congratulations on your victory.]

A humble mantra, resembling a gentle light, resonated.

As the light gradually faded, the constellation's face came into view. A neutral expression, radiant, translucent skin. Clothing that exuded a restrained yet noble air. Even the enormous ring of light rising behind him.

"Nice to meet you."

I knew who this constellation was.

"Lord of December 25th."

[Do you recognize me?]

A mythological constellation from Vedas.

Lord of December 25th, Mitra.

I have no direct connection with him in this worldline.

However, the 'Demon King of Salvation' I read about does. According to the story, Mitra had confronted the Demon King of Salvation, who had just entered the 41st round.

I recalled the appearance of Mitra in the story and thought,

「This isn't the normal state of a 'mythical constellation'.」

He certainly still posed a tremendous threat. If I were to confront him with full force, I wouldn't have the confidence to win.

Even so, the 'presence' I felt from him was somewhat different from the 'mythical constellations' I'd seen in other worldlines or stories.

The strangely faded radiance of his back. And the small wing on his shoulder, which remained.

No matter how I looked at it, he had lost some of his original prestige.

But even in that state, I knew full well that if he so chose, this 'Valhalla Hall' would be devastated. He was a walking natural disaster. That was the 'mythical constellation' before me.

"There's no way I wouldn't know. Your copyright dispute with Eden over the December 25th rights issue is a famous one."

[There was that one time, too.]

Mitra let out a light laugh.

It was a beautiful smile, like sunlight shattering on waves.

"Since you came to see me, that means you're now the owner of 'Valhalla Hall', right?"

[That's right.]

"The match was a fair one."

Mitra is a constellation belonging to Vedas. Then, perhaps, he came to avenge Garuda and Manu, constellations from Vedas who were killed by me.

[I know. I didn't come to blame you for that.]

Mitra shook his head calmly, his expression devoid of hostility.

Still unfazed, I asked in a calm voice.

"Then why did you come?"

Whether of a lower rank or not, the opponent is that 'mythical constellation'. A pillar of a gigantic nebula, a being who ascended to the highest throne in this <Star Stream> world. I couldn't take the expression on his face, which seemed to have lived for tens of thousands of years, at face value.

[I've come to ask a favor.]

"You know, I suppose, that a request from a being can never be considered a 'request'."

Mitra smiled again, perhaps finding my words quite amusing.

[A pure request, in the truest sense of the word.]

What on earth could possibly be the request that a mythical constellation would use such language?

But before I could ask, the constellations appeared behind Mitra.

[Chairman! Great Light! No!]

They were the staff of the 'Hall of Golden Dice', including Skuld.

[You shouldn't compromise your pride! You—]

But their words were cut short. Mitra slowly raised his right hand, placed a long finger to his lips, and all sound in the area died down. Skuld and the other constellations prostrated themselves on the ground, gasping for breath.

I realized what had happened.

「This was the status of a 'mythical constellation'.」

Before the gravity of his absurd 'story', all the other stars were robbed of even their own voices, struggling to maintain their existence.

I was the only one who didn’t bow before him.

Mitra looked at me and said,

[I saw your entire fight.]

He saw my fight. It was an impossible expression. Because my 'fight' took place within the 'Chaos Bush', unobservable from the outside.

But as I met his mysterious eyes, I felt the truth in his words. Perhaps Mitra, using his interpretation of light, had glimpsed into the forbidden thicket.

[I bet—]

Mitra, who had reached that point, furrowed his brow slightly.

A spark of probability flickered in the air. Something strongly restricted his speech.

Mitra stared into space for a moment, then carefully chose his words before continuing.

[Can you forgive the stars?]

I couldn't understand what Mitra was saying. Suddenly coming to me and asking for forgiveness for the stars?

Even more strange was the way I felt shaken by his words.

Is it because I had just seen the constellations on the scaffold? Or perhaps because I, too, was now standing in the same landscape as them?

「There are feelings that those who survived until the 85th scenario cannot help but share.」

Since no one is innocent of the original sin of the scenario, in a sense, all those who survived until the 85th scenario were accomplices.

Those who accepted the scenario's rules and condoned someone's death. We have all lost someone precious at least once, and killed someone out of fierce hostility at least once.

[Please show them kindness. Please stop this tragedy, just this once.]

Standing above that tragic history, the great mythic constellation pleaded with me.

[If you forgive the stars, I will stand on your side.]

Mitra took another deep breath and spoke.

[And all the constellations in this Valhalla Hall will also stand on your side.]

Sparks struck from the air again, even more fiercely than before. The sparks soon pierced Mitra's entire body, burning his incarnation body with pitch-black flames.

「Someone is interfering with Mitra's intervention.」

But who could possibly do such a thing? What being could possibly control a mythic constellation that had descended in scenario number 85?

Even as his entire body burned, Mitra continued to speak.

[Don't you need strength too? If you wish to be 'the last one', if you wish to become the 'Oldest Dream' of all this world—]

His incarnation body began to disappear like light crumbling. His incarnation body was being repatriated somewhere.

I belatedly reached out, but all I could catch was the shards of sunlight.

I couldn't tell where he had disappeared to, but a sight suddenly came to mind.

「The Round Table of Mythical Constellations.」

Perhaps Mitra had been repatriated there.

As Mitra vanished, the pressure that had been weighing down the area was instantly lifted. Skuld and the other constellations, gasping for breath, staggered to their feet and looked at me.

Perhaps it was because of the courtesy Mitra had shown me. Skuld bowed her head to me as if he were Mitra himself and continued speaking.

[Please, we also implore you. Due to the probability of the 'Hall of Golden Dice', we can only delay the compensation payment for today. Once the 'settlement' begins, no one will be able to stop it.]

It was the first time I'd seen a narrative-grade constellation tremble so terribly.

I stared at Skuld with a dry gaze and asked,

"What do you want me to do?"

[That—]

Skuld, who had just finished speaking, was thrown back with a strong impact. Skuld's story cascaded down the floor. The staff of the 'Hall of Golden Dice' hurriedly supported Skuld.

A swirling portal opened in front of them.

[The probability of the nebula, <Olympus>, is moving!]

[The probability of the nebula, <Papyrus>, is moving!]

[The probability of the nebula, <Tree of Guardians>, is moving!]

A series of constellations emerged from within the swirling portal.

Narrative-grade constellations. The moment I saw the aura emanating from their bodies, I had a gut feeling.

「These are the constellations of the 'Main Battlefield'.」

A rugged and noble presence. The spirit and confidence that only those who have challenged the scenarios without giving up can possess flowed through them.

[Is it that person?]

Judging by the atmosphere, it seemed they had come to see me once again. Perhaps they were envoys representing each of the great nebulae.

The problem was that among the envoys, there was a face I already recognized.

[The constellation, 'Ferocious War God', reveals its status.]

I pushed back Anna Croft and the other incarnations with my hand and said,

"Anna Croft-ssi, please step back."

One of the twelve gods of Olympus.

Ares, the Ferocious War God.

Long ago, he descended into the scenario and engaged in a fierce battle with the first, the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', reacts to the 'Ferocious God of War'.]

At that time, Ares was defeated by the Demon King of Salvation and lost a great deal of stories. Then, he discovered me, possessing the story of the 'Demon King of Salvation'. That foul-tempered Ares.

There was no way he wouldn't pick a fight with me.

Indeed, Ares strode towards me as soon as he spotted me. I was preparing to secretly activate [Incite] once more, but Ares stopped exactly three steps ahead and spoke.

[It's a pleasure to meet you.]

I thought I'd misheard, but Ares spoke again.

[I have a proposition for you.]

---

As expected, Ares, the Ferocious War God, was an emissary from <Olympus>.

「Emissaries from each nebula will visit the winner of the preliminary battle and offer to recruit their forces.」

The main battlefield of 'Ragnarok' is the confrontation between the <Asgard> constellations and the forces of Hell.

Even within the same faction, affiliation would vary depending on the constellation, so Ares had come to bring me to the <Olympus> camp.

"Are you telling me to join your ranks again?"

Given Olympus's past behavior, it was obvious what they were going to propose, even without hearing it.

Honestly, I found it incredibly shameless. After tormenting me and my comrades so much, now you want to scout me?

[I didn't say anything like that…]

Ares then raised a large finger and scratched his cheek, adding,

[I'd appreciate it if you did.]

"What is your real purpose?"

Considering Ares's personality, he could have easily been offended by my rude tone, but he continued politely, unfazed.

[You've sufficiently proven your mettle in the 'Skirmish'. You've proven that you can lead an army on your own.]

I'd never seen Ares with such a long tongue before, so I listened to him with some admiration.

[And I saw what you did in the 'New Murim District'.]

In the New Murim District, I killed Apollo, the 'Almighty Sun', one of the twelve gods of Olympus. Now, it seems the other gods of Olympus have learned of this.

I asked, my nerves still high.

"So, have you come here for revenge?"

Apollo, like Ares, is one of the twelve gods of Olympus. So, even if he immediately brandished his sword of vengeance, I would have no recourse.

But what Ares offered wasn't an attack, but an unexpected offer.

[Requesting an alliance.]

For a moment, I thought I'd misheard.

"An alliance?"

[Exactly.]

"You say alliance, but you're going to enslave me for 300 years by bringing in an unfair contract."

[Has Olympus ever done anything like that to you?]

Never to me. But they've done it to Yoo Joonghyuk from another worldline.

[I repeat, I will not do such a thing.]

"Can you swear on the River Styx?"

An oath on the River Styx is the heaviest guarantee the gods of Olympus can make. I didn't think he'd go that far, but surprisingly, Ares nodded obediently.

[I swear.]

Ares' appearance was so different from what I remembered, I honestly couldn't hide my bewilderment.

But it was too early to be surprised.

[We, <Olympus>—]

Ares took a deep breath, looked at me with piercing eyes, and spoke.

[From now on, we have decided to treat you with the respect of a 'myth-grade constellation'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 970 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (2)

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I've heard countless nonsense from <Olympus>, but this was a first.

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', scoffs.]

Using the story of the 'Demon King of Salvation', you want to honor me, who killed one of the twelve gods of <Olympus>, as a being equivalent to a 'myth-grade constellation'? That <Olympus>?

[I think I understand what you're thinking.]

"Aha, you've probably looked back on your own history, haven't you?"

Instead of answering, Ares slowly turned his head and gazed at the scenery of the 'Valhalla Hall'.

Beyond the screen, the constellations in the hall were causing a ruckus. Most of them were those who had bet coins in the Golden Dice Hall. They were screaming, wailing, using force, and being dragged away.

But not everyone was in such turmoil. Some constellations, meanwhile, were contemplating sub-scenarios. To acquire new incarnations, or to find new stories to immerse themselves in, forgetting their 'Valhalla Halls'.

[How do they appear to you?]

I paused, beginning to speak.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation', gazes at the landscape of the 'Valhalla Hall'.]

I felt the story within me staring at the constellations.

Surely, I—Kim Dokja—hated them. But even that hatred, in this world, was merely fuel for the story.

[You must know by now. There are things you can't help but see once you reach the 85th scenario.]

I vaguely understood Ares's meaning. It was the same feeling I had when I watched the executioner with Anna Croft.

[The stars are here because they love stories.]

I couldn't deny those words. Yet, the reason I couldn't help but speak was perhaps because there was still a part of me that believed I was 'human'.

"What you did is unforgivable."

[…]

"Do you think the history of slaughtering and humiliating the incarnations can be justified with such romantic reasons?"

[I have no intention of justifying it.]

Ares said this and looked down at Valhalla Hall again.

A constellation, being dragged away for failing to repay a debt to the Golden Dice Hall, was raging. Watching the constellation finally subdued and suffering a miserable death, Ares spoke.

[That person's modifier is 'God of Peace and Relief'.]

Honestly, he seemed more suited to being called 'God of Wrath and Gambling' than 'God of Peace and Relief.'

[He stayed in this 'Valhalla Hall' and helped many incarnations in lower-level scenarios. Many incarnations in North America survived thanks to his good deeds.]

It was an unbelievable story. To me, the 'God of Peace and Relief' looked like a crazy old man going crazy over a gambling debt.

Ares spoke again.

[The star speaking next to him is the 'Caregiver of Light and Compassion'.]

The constellation Ares pointed to was a gentleman speaking to the 'God of Peace and Relief' being dragged away. The gentleman on the screen—the 'Caregiver of Light and Compassion'—was constantly speaking to the dragged constellations.

[He must be contracting to take in the incarnations of the constellations being dragged away.]

Honestly, I was a little surprised. Taking in the incarnations of fallen constellations?

[He's taking in and nurturing abandoned incarnations like that. But the higher-ranking constellations in the Great Nebula know what that star is really doing.]

On the screen, the 'Caregiver of Light and Compassion', having received a haggard incarnation, wore a kind smile.

[All the incarnations he takes in are used as low-level mercenaries on the 'main battlefield'. They become what's called a 'meat shield'.]

"..."

[And among the incarnations collected, those that seem completely unpromising are sent off as ingredients for banquets like the 'Gourmet Association'.]

"Then that deal—"

[Yes. It's a form of human trafficking.]

I wanted to go and stop the deal right away. But Ares, seeing my expression, shook his head.

[Even if you leave, nothing will change.]

"Still, isn't it better than staying still?"

[You're not even a constellation. Stopping them won't solve the fundamental problem. Are you going to collect the abandoned incarnations?]

Hearing Ares' words, I felt a strange sense of déjà vu. Why was I seeing another constellation as I looked at his expression right now?

[Even if those incarnations remain in this 'Valhalla Hall', there's no future for them. It would be better to wish them the blessing of the story. If they're lucky, they might be able to find a new sponsor in the 'Main Battlefield'.]

Then the screen changed again. This time, the person appearing on the main screen was a constellation I also knew.

Ares smiled dryly, perhaps already aware of this fact.

[You must be familiar with that constellation.]

He was the 'Bald General of Justice'.

A constellation that had been Kim Dokja's longtime supporter and had fought alongside him in the 'Demon King Selection Tournament'.

[What does that constellation look like to you?]

"…"

[That constellation treated you very well, didn't it? Then, would that constellation be considered a good constellation?]

That's right. If there's such a thing as a 'good constellation', it would undoubtedly refer to Samyeongdaesa. Nevertheless, I couldn't quite open my mouth. After all, Samyeongdaesa also observed the lives of the incarnations.

Countless incarnations came and went for his 100 coins. Countless comedies and tragedies must have unfolded before his eyes. He must have felt joy and sorrow reading those stories.

On the screen, Samyeongdaesa gazed upward with blank eyes. The symbol of the shining golden Hall of Dice. D-Coins were falling towards him, radiating a bright beam of light. Perhaps he, too, had bet on this bet.

[That constellation has poured out all its stories over the years for the Prophet who caused the death of his incarnation.]

Samyeongdaesa gazed blankly at the D-Coins falling over his head, then at the empty scaffold.

What words were etched in his mind right now? Was he rejoicing at winning the bet, or lamenting his inability to feel joy even in this situation?

Finally, it was Ares who spoke for me.

[This universe is too dark to read. That's why beings who have become stars must burn themselves to create light. But when you burn yourself to read the stories, there are times when you gradually lose track of what's going on.]

"…"

[Things you once held dear disappear somewhere, and only miscellaneous stories that have crept in from somewhere occupy your mind.]

I turned to face Ares, who spoke without answering.

At that moment, he wasn't the 'Ferocious God of War' I knew. He seemed like the 'Mass-Production Maker', or the 'Queen of the Darkest Spring'.

[And yet, all we can do is read a single line of stories over and over again. That's the tragedy of the damned star born into this <Star Stream>.]

It was truly strange, but he also seemed like Kim Dokja.

"The 'Ferocious God of War' I knew didn't speak like you."

He was the god of war. One of the twelve Olympian gods, who would use any means necessary for victory. Sometimes petty, often tenacious. And strong.

"Are you reborn too? Or do you have amnesia?"

[In the sense that they must burn themselves to read stories, all stars are like amnesiacs.]

"When you burn something, it leaves a mark."

I glared at him and continued.

"No matter how many famous stories you've read or how great your achievements, the marks of the burn will never disappear. They will eventually grow like soot. Records never disappear."

Ares, instead of denying my words, simply looked at me with a pitying look.

[You're right. But if you continue to be haunted by those marks, you won't survive the next scenario.]

"I don't think that's something I should hear from a mere narrative-grade."

Ares's expression changed at the mention of narrative-grade.

[Yes. You're now a 'myth-grade' one.]

For a moment, a myriad of emotions flashed across Ares's face. He licked his lips, seemingly hesitant, before finally asking me.

[What kind of scenery do you see in your world?]

I wonder if the constellations who have stayed as narrative-grade for a long time are still curious about the world of the myth-grade.

Ares hesitated and continued to ask, as if he had heard something from somewhere.

[Is there a Round Table scenery, as rumored? Or is there a completely different cosmic landscape?]

Perhaps that desire is what has driven Ares, the 'Ferocious God of War', to live on.

"Even if I explain, you won't understand."

I had made up a story because I didn't want to say anything, but Ares nodded in response.

[I suppose so. He said the same thing.]

He?

[Anyway, I think you should carefully consider the alliance proposal. Even if you've reached myth-grade status, there are monsters in Ragnarok that even the myth-grade constellations fear. <Olympus> has been your enemy until now, but now it could become your ally.]

"Why are you so desperate to recruit me? Why are you suddenly bending your pride? Don't you possess many myth-grade constellations?"

Ares remained silent for a moment, observing the Valhalla Hall before muttering softly with an inscrutable expression.

[We simply want to see the next story.]

When I turned my head, Ares's incarnation body had vanished. For me, who had expected a fierce battle, it was a somewhat disappointing ending.

So, did <Olympus> change its mind in order to recruit me?

While it felt real that I had indeed attained myth-grade status, I also felt somewhat complicated about this new aspect of Ares. Next to enter the reception room was the narrative-grade constellation of 'Papyrus'. As soon as he entered, he declared to me in an overbearing manner, as if ordering me.

[Demon King of Salvation! Come under the protection of our <Papyrus>! …Huh? Why are you laughing?]

Yes, there must be things that remain unchanging like this.

After chasing away the narrative-grade constellation of <Papyrus> with [Incite], the last constellations to come to me were the narrative-grade constellation of <Guardian Tree> and the judge of <The Underworld>.

[The constellation, 'Goddess of the Morning Star', gazes upon you.]

As expected, the leader of the <Tree of Guardians> was the 'Goddess of the Morning Star', Vakarine, who had a connection with Kim Dokja from the 'Gourmet Association'.

On the other hand, the judge from the <Underworld> who accompanied her was a somewhat unexpected guest for me.

"If it were Olympus's offer, I'd already declined."

[I'm not here as a representative of Olympus.]

I know that. The <Underworld> and <Olympus> are clearly distinct groups. Still, just in case, I asked.

"Did the Father of the Rich Night ask you to bring me?"

At this point, the ruler of the <Underworld> was Hades, the 'Father of the Rich Night'.

If I had to choose a single constellation to ally with, I'd feel more comfortable allying with the <Underworld> than <Olympus>. I thought we'd finally meet them in 'Ragnarok', but the Judge said something unexpected.

[He's not currently the ruler of the Underworld.]

Hades doesn't rule the Underworld? Then is it Persephone?

[The current ruler of the Underworld is the 'God of Wine and Ecstasy'.]

Dionysus, the God of Wine and Ecstasy.

Come to think of it, other recorders in the 'Archives' said something similar. Dionysus became independent from Olympus and formed a new power.

Did that mean the Underworld?

[Demon King of Salvation, let's get straight to the point. We want you to join us.]

"If it's us, does that mean the two nebulae are already allied?"

Vakarine and the Judge nodded simultaneously at my question.

I couldn't believe it, but the <Tree of Guardians> and the <Underworld> are allied.

"What on earth is going on up there?"

If those proud nebulae were joining forces, it meant the scenario unfolding on the 'main battlefield' would be too much for even the nebulae to handle.

I wondered if I could hear some relevant information, but Vakarine shook her head with a dark expression.

[I can't tell you that.]

Perhaps there were restrictions on sharing information about higher-level scenarios here.

Perhaps it was because I seemed disappointed, but Vakarine hesitated for a moment before speaking.

[What we can tell you is that you don't have much time to choose. The 'Valhalla Hall' will close soon. Please choose the stars you will join before it's too late.]

After saying that, Vakarine seemed to ponder something, then added with a slight spark:

[Unless you want to become another 'Kim Dokja'.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 971 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (3)

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If I don't want to end up like other Kim Dokjas, choose the stars I'll be with?

I barely managed to maintain a sense of composure as I stared at the 'Goddess of the Morning Star', Vakarine, and the Judge. I couldn't tell how much they knew.

"What do you mean?"

In situations like this, the best response is to squint.

Vakarine stared at my squinted eyes, then tilted her head and muttered.

[Are you pretending not to know? Or are you really asking because you don't know?]

She activated her detection skills several times, as if trying to gauge my intentions. But with my [Fourth Wall], there was no way that would work.

[Hmm.]

I guess a seasoned, myth-grade constellation is different. Vakarine, unconcerned with her failed skill, calmly exchanged glances with the Judge, then asked me again.

[I thought you were the same as the 'Master of the Erased Margin', weren't you?]

"The Master of the Erased Margin? Who is that?"

Vakarine calmly responded to my impudent question.

[He was the top ranked player in the 'Hall of Golden Dice' before you arrived. You can check it here, so feel free to check it out now.]

Would you mind waiting for me to check it out for myself?

Perhaps because <Tree of Guardians> and the <Underworld> are somewhat smaller than the previous nebulae, I could definitely feel their consideration for me in small details.

Perhaps that means they desperately need 'mythic' power.

Seeing no reason to refuse such a favor, I followed Vakarine's suggestion and immediately looked up the historical rankings for the skirmishes.

After agreeing to a few information security messages, the historical rankings immediately appeared before my eyes.

[You currently hold the title of the highest-ranked player in the 'Hall of Golden Dice' history.]

[Your story resonates throughout the 'Hall of Valhalla'!]

The screen changed with a light congratulatory message.

—1st place. The 'Demon King of Salvation' and the Prophet's team, 'Zarathustra', and the 'Vedas' team.

This ranking is based on the bet amounts recorded in the 'Hall of Golden Dice'.

The matches I participated in involved tens of millions of D-Coins, so regardless of the match content, it wasn't surprising that I ranked first.

What caught my eye was the match ranked second.

A match with a bet amount only slightly lower than mine.

I carefully observed the participants in that match.

—2nd place. The match between Mitra, the mythical constellation of <Vedas>, 'Lord of December 25th', and '■■■'—the 'Lord of the Erased Space That Must Not Be

Mentioned'.

Surprisingly, the participant in the match was Mitra, the owner of Valhalla Hall.

As if reading my expression, Vakarine spoke.

[It seems you've confirmed the match.]

"What exactly is this match?"

The fact that Mitra had engaged in a skirmish wasn't surprising. A cataclysmic event like Ragnarok could easily involve even the mythical constellations residing in the highest-level scenarios.

The problem was the outcome of the match.

—Mitra, the myth-grade constellation, defeated.

I remembered the shock of my first sight of Mitra. I vividly recalled the sight of the constellations, unable to resist the gravity of the light he radiated, prostrating themselves. Mitra, even when not in peak condition, was capable of such power.

And Mitra, who had been defeated?

「Even within the entire <Star Stream>, the defeat of a 'myth-grade constellation' is a rare occurrence.」

Who were these myth-grade constellations? They were the foundation of a nebula, the ones who established the nebula's core giant story and ushered in the creation of the world.

Riding on the backs of giant stories, they manifested omnipotent power.

Such a great being was defeated in a staggering 85th scenario.

[That's why the 'Master of December 25th' was unable to participate in the main battlefield and became the master of this hall.]

Only after hearing her words did I understand why Mitra remained here instead of participating in the 'main battlefield'.

While it's possible that a constellation at the level of Mitra wasn't designated as a 'Resurrected', in any case, a defeat of that caliber would inflict enormous damage on

their stories itself.

Perhaps he received this 'Valhalla Hall' management scenario to minimize the damage.

"Who is the master of the erased space?"

'■■■'—the 'Master of the erased space' that must not be mentioned: he was the mysterious being who defeated Mitra. I had a rough idea of who he was, but I still asked. At the same time, I also expected the constellations wouldn't answer. That's how they always were.

But surprisingly, Vakarine seemed to be pondering it for quite some time.

[Vakarine.]

As the judge uttered a worried incantation, Vakarine raised her head, as if she had made up her mind. A story was slowly starting to speak.

I was honestly impressed. Right now, that narrative-grade constellation was using its power to pronounce just one person's name.

[He is 'Kim Dokja'.]

With a tsutsu sound, a strong spark flew through Vakarine's body. Simply saying the name had affected the probability.

It was strange. 'Kim Dokja' was a common name, and when Vakarine pronounced it before, no sparks had flown.

So why was there a backlash now—the reason was simple.

「The 'Kim Dokja' that Vakarine spoke of just now refers to a single, specific 'Kim Dokja'.」

A name that could only be called with precise probability.

I remembered how the beings of the 'New Murim District' had difficulty pronouncing that name.

Perhaps even with the same name, the probability required to pronounce it varied depending on the precision with which it was identified.

And if it was a 'Kim Dokja' that even the 'Goddess of the Morning Star', who had surpassed the late narrative-grade, would struggle to pronounce—

[We are gathering our strength to confront him.]

No matter how much I thought about it, there was only one person.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja.」

My brother had finally surpassed even the status of a mythical constellation, defeated the fearsome Mitra, and moved on to the next scenario.

And to confront him, the <Tree of Protection> and the Underworld had joined forces and offered me a proposal.

If that were the case, there was only one possible outcome.

"Is he perhaps on the side of 'Calamity'?"

Vakarine didn't answer my question. She simply took a deep breath and continued her speech.

[Probably, many other nebulae will contact you, not just us.]

"After all, isn't the upper-level scenario a showdown between <Asgard> and Calamity? Is there a reason you need to go to such lengths to recruit me?"

[We need you.]

"Are you going to keep saying only what you want to say?"

[We've read the revelation.]

"Revelation?"

The judge stopped Vakarine once again, perhaps because the answer was unexpected.

[Vakarine. If you reveal too much information—]

[I think this is okay. He deserves to know, too.]

The spark of probability flowing through Vakarine's body intensified. She looked at me with unwavering eyes, speaking clearly.

[Every nebula has no choice but to recruit 'Kim Dokja' to win the final war. That's why we're recruiting you.]

As soon as she finished speaking, a sliver of wisdom flowed from Vakarine's lips. Revealing that information had a fatal effect on her.

Nevertheless, I couldn't stop asking questions.

"What do you mean? Are you saying that the other nebulae have already recruited 'Kim Dokja' one by one?"

As my anxiety grew, my questions became more rapid.

"And what exactly did you mean by that first statement? If you don't want to become like other Kim Dokjas, choosing a star is—"

[You're too greedy.]

Vakarine replied with a bitter smile.

[Check the ranking records. The answer you seek will be there.]

With those words, Vakarine's incarnation body began to disperse. She had finally exhausted all probability.

The Judge looked at Vakarine with a bitter expression, then turned to me and added,

[The <Tree of Guardians> and the <Underworld> await your wise choice. May the great Dionysus be with you.]

After the Judge and Vakarine disappeared, I gazed at the empty space they had left, lost in thought.

At least, my meeting with the constellations had ended without a hitch.

「My brother is on the main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'. And the 'other Kim Dokjas'—perhaps my comrades are there too.」

I should have looked into the Wenny King's records. The thought crossed my mind, but even thinking back, it was the best decision at the time.

Knock.

A knock on the door. I opened it, wondering if any of the constellations that had visited me were still there, and a welcoming face greeted me.

"If you're alive, you should tell me you're alive!"

It was Jung Heewon.

---

I briefly relayed to Jung Heewon what had happened since the match.

"Have you really become a mythical constellation?"

Jung Heewon seemed to have a hunch that I'd win, but it all seemed unrealistic.

"Did you bet enough D-Coins?"

"Yes. You said it would more than double? It hasn't arrived yet, though…"

I've also bet 10 million D-Coins, so the potential reward will be at least double that.

「With this, we've acquired enough resources for the upper battlefield.」

Now, the next problem is for everyone to safely move on to the 'main battlefield'.

"Heewon-ssi, you'll have to fight your 'outpost' soon, too."

Actually, this was also a concern.

Jung Heewon hadn't fought her 'outpost' yet.

Even if she was a special-level warrior, if the opposing side was swarmed with late-stage constellations of the narrative grade, she wouldn't have a chance.

"Don't worry. I'm confident I can win."

"Of course you would..."

"But who is that person? I think I saw her at the game earlier."

In the direction Jung Heewon pointed, there was a figure waiting for me, standing with an indifferent expression and awkward posture.

"Oh, let me introduce you."

Come to think of it, was this the first time the two of them had met in person? Since they'd be working together from now on anyway, it wouldn't be a bad idea to get to know each other beforehand.

"Heewon-ssi, this is Anna Croft-ssi."

"Anna Croft-ssi? Are you Korean?"

"Anna Croft-ssi, this is Jung Heewon-ssi."

Anna Croft sighed at my hurried introduction and extended her hand to Jung Heewon.

"Nice to meet you. My name is Anna Croft."

Jung Heewon, her eyes wide, grasped Anna's hand, perhaps already aware of her reputation.

"Anna Croft? Are you the 'Anna Croft'?"

"Yes. She's known as the 'Prophet' outside."

"Wow, I never thought I'd see that Las Vegas gambler in person."

"I've heard rumors about you, too. The Mad Sword Emperor."

"It's an honor."

It seems I was overly suspicious of their social skills.

[The story, 'Regret, Exhaustion, Obsession', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Comrade of the Fear Realm', begins its storytelling.]

While the two were chatting lightly, I checked the ranking records from the skirmish. It was because of Vakarine's last words.

「Check the ranking records. The answer you seek will be there.」

I looked back at the match between 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' and Mitra. I wanted to see the details, but unfortunately, it was banned. It was only natural, since it was a story that exposed the corruption of a myth-grade constellation.

I continued to look through the ranking list. Soon enough, I found a match.

—4th place. The battle between the incarnation of Archangel Yophiel and the incarnation of the Great Heavenly Star against the narrative-grade incarnations of Papyrus.

If it's the incarnation of Archangel Yophiel, then... It must be Killer King. And the incarnation of the Great Heavenly Star... was most likely Ji Eunyu.

I don't know why she, who was supported by King Mihu, was listed as the incarnation of the Great Heavenly Star, but if King Mihu of this round was able to wield the power of the Great Heavenly Star, it wouldn't be entirely surprising.

—Archangel Yophiel, Team Victory.

Heaving a sigh of relief at the fact that the two had safely advanced to the 'Main Battlefield', I continued to check the 'Main Battlefield' records. And soon enough, I discovered another match record.

It was a match ranked 24th in total prize money.

—Baekcheongmunju, the incarnation of 'Sneaky Schemer', and Team Olympus.

Baekcheongmunju and the incarnation of the Sneaky Schemer. I held my breath without realizing it.

Baekcheongmunju must be Master Kyrgios, the 'Paradoxical White Cheong'.

With a strange name like 'Sneaky Schemer'. As far as I know, only one person chose that constellation as their sponsor.

「Dansu ahjussi.」

The problem was the result of that match.

—Team 'Olympus' won.

"What?"

I couldn't believe my eyes. I reread it several times, wondering if I'd misread it, but the record remained unchanged. The team that won that match was Olympus.

But how could that be? Even if the opponent was Olympus, they lost while Master was still there?

I continued reading the record.

—Kyrgios Rodgrim, the White Blue Paradox, was chosen as the Resurrected for that match.

If a team loses in the 'Preliminary Match', only one person from the losing team is designated as the 'Resurrected'. That Master had come back to life here...

「Dansu ahjussi is dead.」

I felt all the strength drain from my body.

「I'm too late this time, too.」

My trembling fingers continued to read the record. I wanted to know every single line about Dansu ahjussi. I wanted to know how he died, what on earth happened in the match.

But while I was looking at the record, I came across a strange line of text.

—'Missing Bush' confirmed to be activated in the match.

Missing Bush.

—Some participants went missing in the 'Missing Bush'.

My heart pounded.

—The following is the list of missing participants.

With a flash of lightning, I found the name I was looking for at the end of the list.

—Incarnation Lee Dansu.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 972 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (4)

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I informed Jung Heewon that I had discovered Lee Dansu’s name within the 'ranking records'.

She was already shaken by the sheer scale of the game we had witnessed, but the news regarding Dansu ahjussi left her truly stunned.

"So he’s actually... still alive?"

"It is highly probable."

"But what on earth is that 'bush'?"

As I was mentally searching for a way to simplify the explanation, it was Anna Croft who spoke up on my behalf.

"As you saw during the match, a 'bush' is a localized event zone that generates randomly in each arena. Fundamentally, it's a place for participants to hide, but special events can trigger depending on the specific properties of that bush."

"Ah, so like that thicket from earlier..."

Anna Croft nodded, acknowledging Jung Heewon's realization.

"The one we entered was a 'Chaos Bush'. It possessed the properties of 'Observation Prevention' and 'Probability Reduction'."

"Then is this 'Missing Bush' something similar?"

"The Missing Bush can manifest if very specific conditions are met, though the probability is infinitesimally low. Selena Kim attempted to track it down in previous scenarios, but she never succeeded."

I had expected as much. I had also tasked Selena Kim with investigating the phenomenon, but I hadn't truly expected the Missing Bush to surface so soon.

"Then what's our move? We have to find that bush to get to Dansu ahjussi..."

This time, we had to find the 'Missing Bush' at all costs. Fortunately, Anna Croft already held the key.

"The probability of a Missing Bush appearing is lowest in a 'Small Battlefield'. To find one, we need scale."

The skirmish arenas were categorized into small, medium, and large formats. While most matches were held in the 'small' format, medium or large battlefields were occasionally triggered when multiple teams formed massive alliances or special events occurred.

"When a 'Large Battlefield' opens, the likelihood of a Missing Bush manifesting increases exponentially."

In other words, to rescue Dansu ahjussi, we had to force our way into a Large Battlefield. Jung Heewon spoke up, her voice steady with newfound resolve.

"Dokja-ssi, you've already cleared your 'Preliminary Battle'. I'll handle the search alone."

"No. I can’t let you walk onto that battlefield by yourself. Anna Croft and I will go with you."

Anna Croft, seemingly resigned to being dragged back into the meat grinder, looked at me with a pensive gaze. However, it was Jung Heewon who interjected first.

"You shouldn't be participating in the 'Battlefield' anymore. You've already satisfied the entry requirements for the upper-level scenario."

"Even if the conditions are met, there's nothing stopping me from re-entering. Just as the other constellations have done—"

"Have you forgotten what you just did?"

Jung Heewon asked, gesturing toward the chaotic roar of Valhalla Hall.

"Do you think those bastards will leave you alone if you set foot in the arena again?"

The wails of the constellations who had lost their fortunes filled the air. By now, the stars had likely gauged the extent of my power. If I returned to the battlefield, they would be waiting for me, fully prepared.

But I was in no position to compromise.

"Heewon-ssi. If our positions were reversed, would you have let me enter that battlefield alone?"

"That's..."

"I feel the same way. I have no intention of leaving my comrades to die while I watch from the sidelines."

Jung Heewon's expression shifted subtly at the word 'comrade'.

[The story, 'Regret, Impoverishment, and Obsession', nods.]

She cleared her throat and spoke again.

"Fine. If that's how it is, Dokja-ssi... but on one condition. You must enter the same battlefield as me. You stay by my side. Understood?"

"I understand."

"Then I'll go ahead and see if I can find anyone else to fill the team. I doubt we'll have many volunteers, given the circumstances."

Anna Croft waited until Jung Heewon had walked a significant distance away before speaking.

"She cares for you quite deeply."

"I feel the same."

Anna Croft smirked, her eyes searching mine.

"I suppose she still has no idea how truly devious you are, right?"

"Yes. I've played the part well."

"She's going to be terribly disappointed eventually."

"My plan is to never get caught."

Anna Croft let out a sharp, sarcastic laugh.

"Then why did you let me find out everything about you?"

"Because you already knew I was a bad guy, didn't you?"

She looked at me with a flicker of genuine agitation in her eyes. I met her gaze and asked simply:

"Will you join me on the next battlefield?"

It was an absurd request. I was asking someone who had just crawled out of hell to jump right back into the fire. But I had to ask.

"I really need you. Both for this skirmish and the main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'."

"You overestimate me. My [Future Sight] is blocked—"

"[Future Sight] isn't the only weapon in your arsenal."

People mocked her for losing her prophetic edge, but Anna Croft was a formidable incarnation even without her foresight. Even Yoo Joonghyuk, who despised her, would have been forced to acknowledge her raw competence.

Anna Croft looked at me for a long moment before letting out a weary sigh.

"Your lip service is exhausting. It's not like I have much of a choice anyway... so, is your grand goal to rescue your old friends from the arena?"

"Exactly. Are you in?"

"Getting there is one thing, but we have a more immediate problem to solve first."

"I know."

Forming a team was fine, but to save Dansu ahjussi, we needed to actually find a 'Large Battlefield' to enter. Such stages were rare and didn't open easily. Especially with Valhalla Hall in its current state of disarray.

"I have an idea."

Fortunately, our brilliant Anna Croft already had a plan.

When we returned to the heart of Valhalla Hall, we were met by Skuld and the rest of the Golden Dice Hall staff. Behind them, bowing as if in apology, stood Mitra—the Lord of December 25th and Chairman of Valhalla. It appeared he had managed to stabilize his incarnation body in the interim.

"We meet again."

Mitra looked even more gaunt than before. He had clearly burned through a massive amount of probability just to solicit my help.

"Why did you vanish earlier? Did the Round Table summon you?"

Mitra’s eyebrows twitched, clearly not expecting me to be so blunt.

[You are aware of the Round Table?]

"I haven't seen it personally, but I've heard the whispers."

It was a hazy memory, like a dream that felt both distant and vivid. The moment I had ascended to 'Myth-grade', I had caught a fleeting glimpse of the Round Table—the seat of the mythical constellations.

In truth, 'round table' felt like an inadequate description.

It was a terrifyingly black, elongated oval. In a sense, that table was a universe unto itself—a vast, dark void that expanded without end.

[Be wary. They are beings who will go to any lengths to curate the playground they desire.]

"Aren't you also a mythical constellation?"

[Beings like me are no longer afforded the title of 'Myth'.]

"May I ask what happened to you?"

[You surely have an inkling of the situation, don't you?]

As I suspected, Mitra's current state was the result of his encounter with 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

He continued, his voice laced with bitterness.

[Every myth is eventually obligated to yield to a newer one. For those of us being pushed out, there are only two paths: burn your stories into nothingness and vanish, or cling to a new myth and live as a parasite.]

"Which path did you choose?"

[Have you considered my proposal?]

That was his answer. He hadn't given up on his story yet. He was dreaming of the day he would reclaim his place in the great narrative and exact his revenge.

"You said you'd stand on my side if I helped you."

[I swear it on the weight of all my stories.]

"Then tell me exactly what you want."

[Do not collect the winnings from your last wager.]

"Are you asking me to act as if the bet never happened?"

[Not at all. If the bet were erased, your own story would lose its potency. I am asking that you simply do not take the D-Coins.]

It was a bold request. I decided to test him.

"And if I refuse?"

[The constellation, 'Lord of December 25th', is observing you.]

"Are you planning to fight me?"

Mitra stared at me with unblinking eyes before slowly shaking his head.

[I think not. Your victory was legitimate. If you refuse, I will harbor no grudge.]

That wasn't quite the level of assurance I needed. I pushed a bit harder, provocation in my tone.

"I've dismantled your constellations from <Vedas> several times now. I've killed 'Thunder-Eater' and the 'General of Vanara'. And yet you claim you won't hold a grudge? Are you being sincere?"

[I guarantee it on the honor of <Vedas>.]

He was serious. He was testifying to me using the full weight of Valhalla Hall's reputation. It was time for me to make my move.

"I cannot simply walk away from the entire bet."

[Then what do you propose?]

"Let's turn it into a debt."

[A debt?]

"You're afraid that if every constellation who lost their coins is dragged to the 'Main Battlefield', the entire ecosystem of Valhalla Hall will collapse. Am I right?"

Mitra's silence was his confirmation. I continued.

"So, I'll lend the D-Coins back to them. I will return my winnings to the losing constellations as an interest-free loan."

Mitra stared at me, clearly not expecting this particular curveball.

"If they have relics or stories of value, I can appraise them myself and write off the debt accordingly."

[You intend to run a pawn shop for the constellations?]

"Something like that."

Mitra let out a bewildered laugh. In truth, I was simply proposing to do exactly what the 'Golden Dice Hall' had been doing since its inception.

"If I return the lost bets as debt, they won't have to pay up immediately."

Settlement. It was a specific mechanic within Valhalla Hall.

「All constellations residing in 'Valhalla Hall' are subject to a 'Settlement Fee'.」

It was effectively a residency tax for constellations who preferred to linger in the 'Preliminary Battles' indefinitely rather than risk the 'Main Battlefield'. Even now, stars were being forcibly dragged to the front lines because they couldn't afford their stay.

Mitra, having listened in silence, asked with a hint of skepticism:

[It could take eons for that debt to be settled. Many of the stars here are malicious; they would steal your coins the moment you turned your back. Are you truly prepared to just hand them over?]

"I never said I'd just hand them over."

[Then?]

"There are conditions."

And this was the crux of why we had come to Mitra in the first place. As the brilliant Anna Croft had said:

「"There is only one being with the direct authority to manifest a 'Large Battlefield' within this hall."」

A star capable of opening the gate we needed.

"Open a Large Battlefield for us."

As the Master of Valhalla, Mitra possessed that authority. He widened his eyes, clearly weighing my intent.

[Why would you ask for that? Do you truly intend to dive into a large-scale conflict?]

"That's the plan."

[Your audacity is remarkable. If a Large Battlefield opens, every constellation in this hall will have their sights on your head. If you've just loaned them D-Coins, the situation will only worsen.]

If I died, their debts would vanish. Naturally, more constellations would flock to the arena just for the chance to kill me. I had already accounted for that.

"It doesn't matter. It'll just make for a better bet."

Mitra looked at me with genuine curiosity before nodding.

[I accept your terms. From this moment, the 'Golden Dice Hall' owes you 10 million D-Coins. In exchange for this contract, you are granted the right to participate in the newly manifested 'Large Battlefield'.]

Mitra raised a hand, and his power began to churn. The entirety of Valhalla Hall shuddered as a massive, swirling quagmire formed in the center of the stadium.

The power of creation. A battlefield was being forged within that swamp, like a primordial soup being stirred. Dirt spread under a canopy of artificial starlight, and life began to flicker into existence upon it.

The moment a microcosm of the universe began to take shape—

Tuduk.

A sound echoed, like something being wrenched out of place in the far distance.

[The constellation, 'Lord of December 25th', is visibly unsettled.]

Only Mitra and I heard it. It was the sound of space-time creaking, tangling upon itself.

[No.]

Mitra's whisper was drowned out by a violent storm that suddenly tore through the dark sky of Valhalla. Fragments of stories were being sucked from the storm and dumped into the stadium. No, those weren't just stories.

「Records.」

The dense clusters of information that dictated [Fate] were pouring down like a deluge, overwriting the shape of the battlefield.

「And so, the final arena of the prelude is born.」

The land Mitra had carefully crafted was instantly reduced to a graveyard of ruins. Dark clouds choked out the clear sky.

「The cowardly stars who hid from the war will finally be called to account.」

[Fate has manifested, overriding the authority of the 'Myth-grade' Mitra.]

Even without Mitra saying a word, I knew whose hand was at work.

「The 'Round Table' has intervened.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 973 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (5)

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Countless lightning bolts struck the hall. Amidst the raging aftershock of probability, a battlefield several times larger than Mitra had envisioned manifested in the center of the hall.

[There has never been a story like this.]

Mitra, gazing into the churning void, muttered with a pale face.

[Round Table... are you determined to destroy all my myths...!]

Mitra's expression, once noble, transformed into that of a cornered demon. Sentences of probability poured from the sky like a deluge. They weren't mere interventions from a scribe or a nebula’s forced [Fate]. They were the natural order of the cosmos—the <Star Stream> itself.

[Zeus! Odin! Ra! Nuwa! Fuxi! Can you truly hear me?]

The myth of Mitra's birth and death defied the natural order of the universe, but the impending odds were too powerful for the ancient myth to resist. Mitra's fingertips began to crumble into pale dust. He turned to me, his gaze heavy with humiliation.

[Demon King of Salvation, I may not be able to keep my promise to you.]

With those words, Mitra's incarnation body was enveloped in a blinding halo of light.

"Wait—"

I reached out, but I stopped. It wasn't just Mitra. The surrounding constellations were also being engulfed in identical halos.

[Ah, ah. This is— Light!]

[No! Stop this!]

The constellations of the 'Hall of Golden Dice' were being forcibly transported.

"Kim Dokja."

Beside me, Anna Croft was fading. In the distance, Jung Heewon was running toward me, her form already dissolving into radiance.

"Dokja-ssi!"

And then, the light claimed me too. As I felt the world shift, the realization struck me.

[A 'Giant Battlefield' has been born in 'Valhalla Hall'!]

A distant laughter echoed through the transition—a strange musical note, a soft whisper telling of the beginning and the end of the world.

「Thus, the long festival of the constellations will finally come to an end.」

Along with the records engraved into the Round Table's universe, the final battlefield of 'Valhalla Hall' was opening.

[From now on, all beings in 'Valhalla Hall' will be summoned to the 'Giant Battlefield'!]

Back when I was writing web novels, I once asked Kiyeon-hyung how to bring characters to life. (Now that I think about it, I'm not sure why I asked him of all people.)

"You have to write as if you were the character," he advised.

"So, do you always write as if you were one of them?"

"Yes."

"But all your characters speak strangely."

"What's wrong with my lines?"

"All your characters laugh like 'Heh heh,' don't they?"

"Because I laugh like that, too."

Thinking I'd asked the wrong person, I went to Ji Eunyu with the same question.

"You shouldn't empathize with your characters too much," she replied. "If you do, only the writer finds the story entertaining."

"But without empathy, won't they lose their vividness?"

She looked puzzled. "Ultimately, characters are the writer's alter ego."

"So should I empathize or not?"

"You should write so the reader can empathize."

"Do you know who your readers are?"

In the end, I never found the answer. I knew nothing about my characters, and even less about the people who would read them. Once I acknowledged that, I lost my grasp on myself as a writer.

What are characters? Are they creations, or are they independent entities merely borrowing my language? How do I write for people I don't know? Who am I, writing an unknown story for an unknown audience?

"Ugh."

When I opened my eyes, I was met with the pitch-black ruins of what looked like a Buddhist altar. Pillars of light flickered in the distance.

[Ugh, ughhhhhhhh!]

[No! Get me out of here!]

The screams of summoned constellations snapped me back to reality.

「We've entered the battlefield.」

A record flashed through my mind. At times like this, it’s helpful to format your thoughts into sentences—to act as if you were the character in the script.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

It wasn't hard to grasp the situation. I had suspected something like this might happen from the moment I entered Valhalla.

「In the face of the Great Destruction, it was a miracle that a system like 'Valhalla Hall' had lasted this long.」

For the constellations on the Main Battlefield, Valhalla was a necessary evil. It provided elite soldiers, but it also drained the potential of those who hid there, resulting in a net loss of strength. This scenario was inevitable. However, as Mitra said, the timing was premature.

Was this solely the will of the 'Round Table'? The answer appeared immediately.

[The main scenario has been updated!]

With a tsutsutsu sound, the face of a Great Dokkaebi manifested in the sky.

[I deeply apologize to the constellations who were startled by this sudden development.]

I recognized him instantly.

「Great Dokkaebi Baram.」

His appearance was met with a chorus of indignant roars.

[What is the meaning of this!]

[Summoning us to a battlefield without warning? Is this the Bureau's idea of management?]

[This is a violation of our status!]

This wasn't some low-level scenario; it was Scenario #85. It was a late-stage arena filled with Narrative-grade beings. Their sense of entitlement was absolute.

[The constellation, 'Brash Swamp Predator', indignantly points a finger at the Administration Bureau!]

[The constellation, 'Gourmet of the Quiet Isle', laments the Administration Bureau's tyranny!]

[The constellation, 'Master of the White Castle', surveys the battlefield with displeasure.]

The modifiers were familiar—members of the Gourmet Association. They, too, had been lounging here instead of fighting.

[I understand your grievances.]

Baram continued, ignoring the outcry.

[However, constellations, we cannot allow this festival to continue indefinitely.]

He surveyed the field with a calm, piercing gaze.

[Is 'Valhalla Hall' truly what you desire? Is it the non-existence you wished for—waiting for others to clear the path while you exhaust your remaining starlight in a cage?]

The resentment subsided for a heartbeat. His words had struck a nerve.

[Have you forgotten the thrill of your first scenario? The memory of your first item? The days you spent accumulating your first stories? Gaining allies, slaying arch-enemies, completing the impossible—have those memories truly faded?]

The story of the <Star Stream> flowed above the ruins.

「"You crazy bastard! If you don't kill, you'll die too!"」

「"It doesn't matter."」

Surprisingly, it was my story.

「The first scenario—the scene of 'Proof of Worth'.」

The stars watched. Yet, what they saw was different for each of them.

「The stars see the same story, yet they each read a different one.」

They were likely recalling their own 'Proof of Worth', their own ancient origins and distinct eras.

[Eventually, all starlight will extinguish, and the universe will return to silence. The moments we cherished will be reduced to a single line, or perhaps nothing at all.]

Like the manager of a failing amusement park, the Great Dokkaebi spoke with somber weight.

[Scenario #85 is a high-level stage, but it is not the end. Burn everything you have. Enjoy the struggle. Pioneer the tale. You are still within the scenario.]

Even without [Incite], Baram's speech was moving. But some emotions only affect those willing to feel them.

[Is the Bureau calling this a 'scenario' now!]

[Great Dokkaebi! Are you mocking us?]

[I paid a fortune in residence fees for Valhalla!]

[Where is the Chairman? This is a scam!]

[Yes... something that should never have happened has happened.]

Looking at them, I thought of the incarnations who had risen in the New Murim District.

「Some memories possess no power.」

To reach this stage, these stars had survived countless tragedies. They had lost everything and gained the world. And now, at the summit, they were obsessed with a single fear.

「I don't want to fall.」

They didn't want to be eliminated. They didn't want to die. Rather than being remembered as a great line in history, they preferred to remain eternal spectators in the shadows.

[Chairman! Reveal yourself!]

I understood that sentiment. I wouldn't call it wrong. But they had to realize the truth by now.

[Cancel this immediately! What are the Great Nebulae doing?]

The rules of the world they enjoyed were finally being applied to them.

**[Main Scenario #85 – The End of Sloth]**

Category: Main

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: Survive the 'Super-Large Battlefield' and join the 'Main Battlefield'.

Time Limit: None

Reward: ???

Failure: Death

[Survival Conditions]

—Hunt a 'warrior' stronger than yourself.

—Or hunt five or more warriors of the same rank as yourself.

—Hidden 'sanctuaries' will appear on the battlefield at regular intervals.

[Sanctuary Rules]

—When a Sanctuary appears, a five-minute timer starts.

—After the timer expires, the twenty participants standing within the Sanctuary's light will be transported to the 'Main Battlefield'.

Amidst the chaos, I read the window. A massive battlefield—the first of its kind in Valhalla history. The goal was simple: survive.

The first condition was brutal. Intermediate warriors had to hunt Advanced-level or higher. Advanced had to hunt Special-level.

The second was no easier: five warriors of your own rank.

The final condition was the only one that seemed feasible for those unwilling to fight.

[My goodness... we actually have to do this?]

[Let me out! I'm telling you to let me out!]

Most of them hadn't participated in a real scenario in eons. They were content to watch incarnations, sustaining themselves on the stories of others. Risking their own lives was a forgotten concept.

[Kill a constellation stronger than me? That's insane...]

Like children in the first scenario, the constellations grew wary, distancing themselves. Some fled into the bushes. Others tried to find strength in numbers.

[Is there any constellation willing to join us?]

[We need a team! If we unite, we can overcome this!]

The first to call out was a high-ranking constellation from the border regions.

[If anyone wants to— Kaaaaaaak! Wait! What are you doing!]

An arrow pierced his shoulder before he could finish.

[Kill him.]

Five or six constellations swarmed from the shadows like lynxes. In an instant, the Great-grade constellation was torn apart, his story disintegrating before he could utter a final word. Their leader bit into the severed arm of the dead star and spat it out.

[Intermediate? Worthless. Find me an 'Advanced' or higher.]

I recognized him immediately.

[The constellation, 'Black Wolf Reaper', lets out a ferocious howl!]

The Black Wolf Reaper—Anubis, the Narrative-grade constellation from <Papyrus>. I quickly ducked behind cover, checking my status.

[You are currently a 'Special Warrior'.]

My value had skyrocketed after the previous battle. If I were caught, I’d be the ultimate prize.

[Run! It's Papyrus!]

As the wolves led by Anubis roared, the surrounding constellations scattered in a panic. I held my breath, waiting for them to pass.

[There was definitely a scent here...]

Anubis sniffed the air near my hiding spot, but his eyes slid right past me.

[The story, 'Pebble and I', begins its storytelling!]

I was currently nothing more than a stone.

[Hmm. Did I misread the trail?]

I wasn't afraid of them, but now wasn't the time to move. I waited for the pack to recede, but then, a hand tapped me on the shoulder.

It should have been impossible. Under the effect of 'Pebble and I', I was undetectable.

Unless... there was only one person who could find me like this.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 974 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (6)

"Kim Dokja."

Only after hearing her voice did I breathe a collective sigh of relief.

"Anna."

「'Pebble and I' does not work on anyone who has ever shared the effects of the story. Anna Croft had once shared this story with me, so she found me completely unaffected by its masking effect.」

However, Anna Croft, who was now clutching my shoulder, seemed to be in an erratic state.

"Are you hurt?"

Anna shook her head as if it were nothing, wiping a smear of blood from her forehead. Judging by her ragged breathing, she had clearly been chased by someone powerful on her way here. Before I could speak again, she placed a finger to her lips and initiated a [Direct Transmission].

—The constellations are coming.

A moment later, a group of constellations appeared, their presence loud and intrusive, from the direction she had fled. These were the ones pursuing her.

—The <Emperor>'s forces.

With Anna's warning, I identified the constellation leading the charge. It was a handsome man carrying a massive red bow on his back—one that seemed even taller than he was. He wore character-themed pajamas that looked absurdly out of place on a battlefield, looking around with a gloomy, perpetually annoyed expression as he clutched a white arrowhead. I knew him well.

「Sun Hunter, 'Hou Yi'.」

He was a legendary constellation said to have shot down nine suns with his arrows. It appeared the forces of <Emperor> participating in this skirmish were under his command.

—Were they hunting you?

Anna Croft shook her head.

—To be precise, they rescued me.

—Rescued you?

According to Anna, the <Emperor>'s constellations, led by Hou Yi, had saved her from a group that had surrounded her earlier.

—The Emperor is attempting to recruit me. They want me to join their vanguard on the 'Main Battlefield'.

This 'Large-scale Battlefield' was the last chance for major nebulae to scout the elites of Valhalla. In that sense, a Prophet like Anna Croft was a prize worth claiming. Though she was despised by Asgard, with Valhalla already teetering on the edge of collapse, the Emperor had no reason to fear the petty disapproval of other nebulae.

—Why didn't you accept? The Emperor stands a real chance even in the final scenarios.

Anna’s eyes widened in genuine bewilderment.

—Are you serious?

—Yes. You’ve already been abandoned by Asgard, haven't you?

When we met in the past, within the Realm of Fear, she was already being systematically hunted by her own nebula. Relying on the Transcendent Alliance had been her last resort, but now that refuge was gone. Accepting a call from another giant nebula was, logically, her best survival strategy.

Anna Croft shook her head stubbornly.

—I am sick of giant nebulae. And…

She hesitated, casting a fleeting glance at me.

—You have no intention of joining them either, do you?

—Of course not.

—Then be quiet. We must be careful of [Detection].

I nodded. Hou Yi was a constellation who had reached the pinnacle of Transcendence, much like Cheok Jungyeong. At this range, even a whisper could be picked up by his senses.

[What a dismal battlefield. The souls of incarnations who perished in despair are screaming everywhere.]

Hou Yi had been mentioned briefly in 'Ways of Survival', but his personality had never been fleshed out.

[Do not weep. In the end, all stars are destined to return to a single dream. Both the brilliant sun and the pebbles on the roadside will ultimately become nothing more than the dust of a story.]

Judging by his tone, he was a surprisingly sentimental constellation. The subordinates approaching him prostrated themselves immediately.

[O Sun Hunter!]

Hou Yi didn't respond. He simply gazed at the artificial sky, lost in thought. His followers, familiar with his temperament, waited in respectful silence. Finally, as a star streaked across the sky, Hou Yi spoke.

[I heard there are Transcendents who escaped the Realm of Fear. Is there any news? What of Jungyeong? What of Namgung Minyoung? Or Kyrgios?]

I felt a jolt of surprise at the names he uttered.

[I came here to learn the fate of my comrades.]

[The Five Emperors promised that if you complete your mission, they will mobilize the Bureau's full intelligence to locate them.]

The 'Five Emperors'—he was referring to the Myth-grade constellations of <Emperor>. Hou Yi scoffed at his subordinate's words.

[You are always the same. Always planning to manipulate me. What star do you want me to bring down this time?]

It made sense. Hou Yi wasn't a central figure in the 'Journey to the West' scenario, the pride of <Emperor>. Like Surya or Dionysus, he didn't necessarily align with the overarching will of his nebula.

[So, what is my task?]

[The Emperor has issued two commands. The first is to recruit the Prophet from <Asgard>.]

[The woman who fled? She clearly has no desire to join us.]

Hou Yi frowned, looking annoyed.

[There is no need to force her. She will learn her place once she advances to the higher scenarios. She will realize that hiding behind the starlight of a Nebula is the only way to stay safe.]

[A mission I can afford to fail, then.]

[However, the second mission must be fulfilled at all costs.]

[And that is?]

The subordinate paused before speaking with cold precision.

[We are to capture the 'Demon King of Salvation'.]

Anna Croft flinched beside me, but I wasn't surprised. This was the logical progression. With the 'Round Table' in motion, there was no reason for other mythic entities to stay idle.

[The Five Emperors ordered that he be brought in without fail. They have authorized the use of the 'White Arrows' if necessary.]

[The White Arrows?]

I swallowed hard. Hou Yi was a constellation of the Sun, but he possessed a specific relic that posed a mortal threat even to Myth-grade beings. Hanging from his flank were ten glowing white arrows.

「A mythical relic—the 'Ten Fingers of God'.」

They were forged from the severed fingers of 'Di Ku', one of the Three Emperors.

「If I am struck by those arrows, even I will be in danger.」

Hou Yi looked genuinely startled by the authorization.

[Really? You understand the implications of using these.]

[The order is absolute.]

[These arrows are meant to bring down stars of calamity. Is this 'Demon King of Salvation' truly such a threat?]

[Reports suggest he possesses status beyond the late Narrative-grade. Possibly even early Myth-grade.]

[A constellation I have never heard of. Is it an Outer God? Or perhaps a Transcendent who ascended?]

[I heard he is an Incarnation.]

Hou Yi’s expression shifted to one of genuine intrigue. He lightly stroked his bow, a slow, inscrutable smile spreading across his face.

[If that is true... then this might actually be interesting.]

I wondered if it was my imagination, or if his gaze had just flickered toward the very bush where Anna and I were hiding. He tilted his head, then looked away.

[Let us prepare. We must secure the 'Demon King of Salvation' before the first Sanctuary closes.]

I watched their movements, a realization dawning on me.

—Did they try to find my location through you? Is that why you ran?

Anna continued to monitor the Emperor’s forces.

—I simply didn't want to be a piece on their board anymore.

If I abandoned her now, I’d never hear the end of it from my comrades. Maintaining 「Pebble and I」, I grabbed Anna’s wrist and began to move. Fortunately, the Emperor's forces remained unaware of our transit.

—First, we need to find Heewon-ssi.

That was the priority. If the rules of the Giant Battlefield held, she would be a prime target without a team.

—And we need to find the 'Missing Bush'. It has to have manifested by now.

That was our true objective.

—If we find it, we can bypass the clearing conditions and survive the scenario.

—Are you really going in there?

—Yes.

—But we don't know where it leads. It could be a death trap.

It was a massive risk. Even 'Ways of Survival' was vague about the destination of the 'Missing Bush'. But if my intuition was correct...

Thud.

A heavy footstep shook the earth. I turned my head.

Thud.

The constellations of <Emperor>, and even the <Papyrus> hunters in the distance, froze as if entranced.

—Kim Dokja...

Anna’s voice was trembling. The air on the battlefield vibrated with a suffocating pressure. It was a cocktail of greed, anxiety, fear, and warped joy. There was no mistaking this sensation.

「I knew the origin of this sound.」

It was the sound of a star of immense status colliding with the weight of its own story.

—A Myth-grade constellation.

In the direction of the ruined forest, a Myth-grade being was unleashing its full status. Fleeing stars and hunters alike turned back, drawn like moths to a primordial flame.

「The instinct to be part of a great record.」

Anna grabbed my sleeve.

—You cannot go there.

She was right. Usually, I wouldn't take such a risk. But there was a reason I had to.

—No, I must.

It wasn't just curiosity about a clash between myths. It was a voice—a story only I could hear.

[The story, 'Regret, Impoverishment, and Obsession', continues its storytelling.]

A familiar story was screaming for me. Anna’s expression hardened as she read my intent.

—No way…

As if synchronized, we bolted toward the forest. To anyone nearby, we would have looked like two very fast stones rolling through the debris. When we reached the treeline, I froze. The pressure was so thick it was hard to draw breath. Great-grade constellations that had rushed in were screaming.

「Eternity. The dawn of the universe. Light following the first point of creation.」

With a collective shriek, the stars nearby dissolved into pure light. Unable to withstand the unfiltered status of a myth, they were being vacuumed into a vortex of tales.

Standing beside me, Anna was gasping for air, her eyes fixed upward. A giant of light was shining brilliantly in the absolute darkness. It was a Myth-grade being with an appearance reminiscent of a colossal archangel.

「Mitra, the Lord of December 25th.」

I knew he was strong, but seeing him unleash his true nature was a terrifying reminder of what I was now up against.

[Protect the Chairman! The Sanctuary is appearing!]

It seemed the Sanctuary was manifesting in this very forest. Skuld and the remnants of the Golden Dice Hall were huddled there, protected by Mitra's radiance.

[Kaaaaaaah! Chairman! Chairman—!]

Then came the scream. It was wrong. Mitra was there, protecting them with the great light of myth that none should be able to defy. Yet, the circle of light was shrinking.

「As if the darkness were slowly devouring the light itself.」

Thud.

The footsteps I had heard earlier—they weren't Mitra's.

Thud.

With every step, Great-grade constellations simply vaporized. It was a monstrous feat—incinerating stars with the mere sound of a stride.

「Something was staring back from the darkness of the beginning.」

Mitra roared and swung a fist of pure light, but the darkness caught it. It coiled around his arm, effortlessly snapping his one remaining wing.

[Ooooooooooo—!]

A horrific scream tore the sky in half. Mitra's massive form began to buckle under the weight of an impossible violence. When the master of that darkness finally stepped into the light, my breath stopped. The one who had broken Mitra's wings—I knew him better than anyone.

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 975 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (7)

'Ways of Survival' features a multitude of beings born from the 'Primal Darkness'. The most prominent example was the 'Wenny King', a creature born alongside the 'Dokkaebi King' in the first Myeongyang. Then there were those who reached the Primal Darkness through the weight of their own myths—beings like the ruler of the abyss, Abaddon, or the lord of the spirit world, Hades. Some had even plummeted into that darkness through their own corruption, such as the Archangel Michael or the high-ranking Demon Lords. Regardless of their origin, every being that embraced the Primal Darkness shared a singular trait.

「They were already mythical, or existence itself had brought them infinitely close to it.」

The star that had materialized before my eyes was no exception. I knew I would see him eventually, but I never expected to encounter him like this.

"Anna Croft-ssi, stay back. No matter what happens, do not approach."

I shoved her behind me and stepped forward. As if triggered by my movement, a record surged before my eyes.

「The pitch-black shadow of a light dragon shimmered within the thick darkness. Merely meeting its gaze was enough to choke one with pure murderous intent. The most sublime

and solemn entity in this universe coiled there, watching me.」

I swallowed hard and recited his epithet.

"Abyssal Black Flame Dragon."

The star that ruled the Nebula <Black Cloud>—the one who had been Han Sooyoung's sponsor in the original story.

「Why is he here? Why has he descended to attack Mitra?」

[No... run...!]

Mitra, struggling beneath the dragon's weight, let out a ragged cry. I looked up at the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon. The entity revealed within the darkness had taken the shape of a colossal black dragon. I opened my mouth to pay my 'respects'.

"Master of the Great <Black Cloud>."

The Black Flame Dragon I remembered was a high-tier Narrative-grade. But the beast before me now was undeniably Mythical. Even the malice radiating from its form was fundamentally different—darker, heavier. How had this happened? Why had he become such a sinister, mythical disaster? I didn't have the luxury of wondering. I needed to buy time.

「The rebound from the 'Demon King of Salvation' form is still tearing at me.」

My strength hadn't fully recovered. If I clashed with a Mythical-grade constellation now, I wouldn't just be reduced to fragments; I'd be erased. And if I failed, Jung Heewon would die with me. I spotted a transparent thicket at the edge of the mythical battlefield.

[The story, 'Regret, Exhaustion, and Obsession', continues its storytelling!]

Heewon's voice resonated from within. She and several other incarnations were huddled inside a transparent barrier. I recognized it immediately.

「Exposed Bush.」

Its function was simple: you could be seen from the outside, but you were immune to damage.

[The 'Exposed Bush' will expire in five minutes.]

The immunity was a one-time grace period. Jung Heewon was tending to the wounded, likely having sought refuge there the moment the myths began their clash. But the bush was situated right at the feet of the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon. Once that timer hit zero, they would be obliterated by the mere aftershocks of the fight.

「I have to stop this fight before that timer runs out.」

"Abyssal Black Flame Dragon!"

He didn't listen. He simply began to crush Mitra beneath a massive, scaled foot.

[Ooooooooooo—!]

Hearing Mitra's screams, I took another step.

"Can't you hear me?"

A Myth-grade star wouldn't hear the voice of a mere human. I drew a deep breath and cast my incantation.

[Abyssal Black Flame Dragon! You, who are closer to being the 'Final Dragon' than anyone else... how did you end up like this?]

The dragon's head turned slowly toward me. It felt as if the universe's abyss was peering into my soul. I pushed the 'Giant Story' to its limit to keep from collapsing under that gaze.

[I am asking why a Great Constellation such as you is acting as a pawn on this trivial stage.]

In the original text, the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon was a candidate for the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse'. But here, he didn't look like a herald of the end. He looked like a puppet.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja blocked the signs of the Holy Demon War in 'The Night of the Blue Witch'.」

The pieces clicked. Because that war never happened in this 41st round, the 'Final Dragon' was never born.

「The prevention of that war... did it break the Black Flame Dragon?」

I didn't know if this was the intended plot of this worldline, but the result was clear.

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', is activated!]

Deprived of his destiny, he had been consumed by rage and grief, spewing forth a narrative of corruption.

[Are you willing to abandon your pride just because you failed to become the Final Dragon? Did you endure for eons just to become a mindless disaster on a battlefield?]

I never claimed he was a 'good' constellation. He was a being who aspired to be the worst disaster in the <Star Stream>. But...

「There was always a certain purity to the Black Flame Dragon.」

I only knew him through records—perhaps they were just Han Sooyoung's filtered perceptions. But that's how we read people.

「The dragon who reveled in Kim Dokja's misfortune but shared a mischievous bond.」

「The immature constellation who believed himself to be a fifteen-year-old child, hiding a bandaged hand.」

「The star that fought to protect a single reader until the very end.」

[That isn't the dragon I knew.]

When we claim to understand someone, we are always telling ourselves a story.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', roars!]

I kept talking, even as the pressure threatened to crush my ribs.

[Even if this is my own arbitrary misreading. Even if this isn't the story of this worldline.]

The story of the 'Demon King of Salvation' poured out of me. I projected the image of the dragon I remembered.

[That was you. I read it. So—]

I was trying to turn reality into one giant incitement.

[I know this isn't your will.]

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', winces in pain.]

The darkness began to shift. Sentences poured out of the void as if to argue with me.

「The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon frowned at the insect before him. How could a human he had never met speak so recklessly of his soul?」

"No... that wasn't you."

「He was an evil dragon. This <Star Stream> was destined to become the ultimate disaster. He was the star that would defeat Mitra here and claim a higher place in mythology.」

[How long will you surrender yourself to a 'record' written by someone else?]

The dragon's massive form stilled. I looked into the shadows behind it. The primal darkness. And then, I heard it. A laughter I loathed.

【That was quite the moving speech.】

I should have known. A star with such a massive ego doesn't just become a 'Mad Dragon' overnight. The world turned a sickly, pale gray. Spacetime warped into the clock of the 'Recorders'. Behind the dragon stood a man in a pitch-black gothic suit.

"Asmodeus."

【It has been a while, Kim Dokja.】

He studied me, his eyes narrowing.

【I've heard the rumors. Have you truly reached 'Myth-grade'?】

"Yes."

You can't lie to the 'Recorder of Fear'.

[What are you doing here?]

【What does a Recorder do? I am recording.】

[Release the Black Flame Dragon. Now.]

【And if I refuse?】

[There will be a price.]

Asmodeus laughed.

【A price? From me? You are in no condition to threaten anyone. Do you think you can defeat the 'Mad Dragon King' I am currently writing?】

[Is that the best name you could come up with? Your naming sense is as poor as your record.]

【Sharp tongue. Let's see if it can save you.】

The scenery shattered. The dragon lunged. I spun my 'Giant Story' like a shield. But the dragon's tail bypassed space-time, striking me from a blind spot and wrapping around me with crushing force.

"Hmph...!"

Kudududuk. The stories of the 'Demon King of Salvation' groaned under the pressure.

【As expected... a Myth-grade earned only with a tongue. This is Scenario #85. Did you truly believe you could best a Mythical dragon? I look forward to the expressions of the Great Beings when I present them with your head...】

I didn't panic.

"Really?"

Asmodeus's smile faltered.

"Are you truly curious about that?"

"Black Dragon! Finish him—!"

[The constellation, 'Demon King of Salvation', unleashes his status!]

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', activates to its fullest!]

I poured my essence into a single mantra.

[I am here!]

The voice resonated across the entire battlefield.

[The 'Demon King of Salvation' is here!]

Silence fell. The stars twinkled in anticipation.

[The constellations of the Great Nebula, <Asgard>, have confirmed your location!]

[The constellations of the Great Nebula, <Vedas>, have confirmed your location!]

[The constellations of the Great Nebula, <Olympus>, have confirmed your location!]

Asmodeus regained his sneer.

【The Mythical ones on the main battlefield are too busy for you. If you thought they'd come for you—】

[I know they're busy. But that isn't who I called.]

The sound of a bowstring being pulled taut echoed, as if the Earth’s axis itself were being strained.

[The constellations of the Great Nebula, <Emperor>, have confirmed your location!]

A brilliant white light pierced the horizon. Hou Yi was aiming.

「The Ten Fingers of God.」

Asmodeus roared in realization, but he was too late.

[Release him, evil dragon.]

The arrow of the sun ignited the sky.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 976 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (8)

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The 'Ten Fingers of God' wielded by the Sun Hunter were sacred relics representing the absolute will of Emperor Di Ku, the third of the Five Emperors.

「The direction his arrowhead points is the decree of the Emperor himself.」

The <Emperor's> 'Giant Story' coiled around the relic like a living serpent, causing every star in the vicinity to let out a collective, trembling sigh.

[Oh, ohhh—]

[The White Arrow of the Emperor!]

The constellations, recognizing the artifact, couldn't suppress their fervor. It was only natural; according to Bicheonhori's '100 Strongest', that arrow was the very relic that had elevated Fei Hu into an incarnation comparable to Yoo Joonghyuk.

「In several worldlines of 'Ways of Survival', Fei Hu, the exclusive incarnation of <Emperor>, inherits that arrow.」

The fact that Hou Yi still wielded it meant that Fei Hu had yet to succeed the Sun Hunter’s lineage in this particular round. Asmodeus, staring at the white-glowing arrowhead, narrowed his eyes and hissed.

【Emperor... are you truly prepared to confront me now?】

Hou Yi’s brow furrowed. He, too, seemed to have finally pierced through the disguise to sense the Recorder’s true identity.

[I am, Great Recorder.]

【I did not ask a mere Narrative-grade. Is this an action sanctioned by the Myth-grade entities of your nebula?】

[I am indeed just a Narrative-grade constellation, however...]

Hou Yi didn't hesitate. He pivoted the arrowhead toward the Black Flame Dragon.

[This arrow is anything but 'mere'.]

I studied the relic in his grasp. Each of the 'Ten Fingers of God' possessed a distinct, specialized power. And the one he held now—

「The second finger of Di Ku.」

I felt as if an entire epoch of history were being compressed into a single point. A cold sweat traced a path down my spine. Just looking at that arrow made me feel as if I were standing face-to-face with 'the one who gave birth to the King of Kings'.

「Di Ku was watching.」

The monarch who had crushed countless stars across endless battlefields, the sovereign who had woven an impenetrable narrative through eternal war—he was pointing his index finger directly at us.

「The index finger of the God who issues the command.」

The heavens began to press down. Every star belonging to <Emperor> across the universe focused its gaze on this spot. The flickering, howling, and screaming of the stars echoed the arrow's intent.

「His finger, pointing toward the end of the world, transcends all probability to gather the eyes of the cosmos.」

A single thread of narrative, spun from the collective starlight of every constellation in the sector, was threaded into Hou Yi's bow. The moment he released it, I was struck by the hallucination of a falling star crashing toward me.

【You are truly serious, then.】

Asmodeus gritted his teeth. The sentences radiating from his form began to forcibly reconstruct the Black Flame Dragon's story.

「In the forgotten abyss of the ancient dragon, an ominous egg hatched.」

「That dragon shall grow into a merciless disaster, devouring both light and shadow, until its infinite greed consumes every spark of starlight in existence.」

Seeing those emblems, I recalled the <Black Cloud Foundation> from the New Murim District—a corporation designed to farm D-Coins and train ascendants.

「But the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon I knew would never run such a tedious organization.」

The Black Flame Dragon reigned as the head of <Black Cloud>, but he never 'ruled'. He was like Yoo Joonghyuk—a sovereign who existed as a symbol rather than an administrator. The fact that he had established a foundation in the lower scenarios was a glaring anomaly.

「What if this entire architecture was Asmodeus's design?」

A pillar of pitch-black flame erupted from the dragon's maw. It resembled [Black Flame], but it was far more solitary, far darker—a flame of absolute contradiction, closer to void than light.

「Breath of the Abyss.」

The flame, seemingly devouring all ambient light, collided with the Emperor's White Arrow.

[Every constellation in the vicinity is captivated!]

[Some constellations have been blinded by witnessing the clash of myths!]

A heart-pounding pressure enveloped the battlefield. Witnessing it felt as though the very essence of the universe was being wrung out. Through the deafening roar, I watched the lights of the blinded stars extinguish. I desperately expanded my status to shield my incarnation body.

[You have witnessed a Great Battle!]

[The seeds of a new story have begun to sprout!]

A surge of adrenaline raced through me. This was the raw elation of witnessing a high-level battlefield firsthand.

[The constellations of <Emperor> stand as a vanguard behind the Sun Hunter!]

But the clash wasn't over. Framed by a backdrop of brilliant constellations, Hou Yi stood in the sky, his face pale but determined.

[What a magnificent beast you've created.]

A vortex of black dust swirled. At the heart of the light and shadow, the dragon—now twice its original size—gleamed with crimson eyes.

Ohhhhhhh—!

Even with my Myth-grade status, that roar nearly shattered my focus. The dragon, bolstered by Asmodeus's records, possessed terrifying power. Despite a massive wound on one wing, it had neutralized the 'Finger of God' with minimal damage. Hou Yi muttered under his breath.

[Are you drawing upon the Nebula's probability in addition to your own?]

I saw it too—the Grand Narrative of the nebula embedded in the dragon's scales.

[The probability of the Nebula, 'Black Cloud', resides within the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon!]

In this version of the story, the souls of every evil dragon who had perished in history now resided within him. This narrative had been fueled by the massive amount of D-Coins harvested from the lower scenarios.

[A colossal amount of 'D-Coins' has been expended!]

[The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon's activity has been temporarily restricted!]

【My turn now.】

Asmodeus smiled with triumph. Hou Yi's complexion turned ashen.

「The Ten Fingers of God require a recovery period after the first strike.」

Until the reload was complete, Hou Yi had to face a Mythical entity with only his own strength.

【Stars of the Emperor, did you think you could rewrite my record with a few fingers?】

Perhaps if he had fired multiple arrows at once, the outcome would be different. But with the first shot blocked, Asmodeus had seized the momentum. Or so he thought.

"Actually, I think he already changed it."

Asmodeus blinked, looking around in confusion. A sentence manifested in the air.

「The Black Flame Dragon's tail, pierced by the arrow’s light, began to bleed.」

Only then did Asmodeus realize.

【No way.】

From the start, Hou Yi’s goal hadn't been to kill the dragon, but to rescue me. I had seized the moment of impact to slip through the dragon’s grip. From across the battlefield, Hou Yi sent me a [Direct Transmission].

—Run, Demon King of Salvation.

It was an unexpected gesture from a constellation of <Emperor>.

—The Emperor desires you. You must not die here.

Whether it was loyalty to his nebula or his own inherent code, I couldn't say. But I had a debt to repay.

—If I leave, you and your followers will be slaughtered.

—It does not matter.

Hou Yi looked ready to embrace death. Retreating with Jung Heewon and Anna Croft when the 'Exposed Bush' expired was the logical move. But I couldn't do it.

「I can never ignore a character with an expression like that.」

I sent a message back.

—That’s a pathetic thing to say. Kyrgios or the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint would be ashamed to hear it.

Hou Yi’s eyes snapped to mine.

—How do you know those names? Where are they? Who are you?

—Are you curious?

I gave him a meaningful smile.

「Hou Yi accepted the Emperor's contract solely to find news of his lost comrades.」

I didn't know the location of every Transcendent, but I knew enough about the Sword Saint to make a deal.

—Let’s fight. We’ll forge a legend here by toppling a Myth-grade entity. Do that, and I’ll tell you everything I know about the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.

Hou Yi stared at me, stunned.

—Are you insane? That is a monster empowered by a Great Recorder.

—The record.

I smiled and added:

—I can rewrite that, too.

I turned toward the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon. His eyes, radiating a lethal abyssal aura, were locked onto me. He was undeniably a Myth-grade being, but there was a hollow resonance to his story—as if the source was corrupted. Asmodeus spread his arms, a predatory grin on his face.

【I knew you wouldn't run. Your greed is your greatest flaw. Do you truly intend to challenge me?】

Normally, I wouldn't dream of engaging Asmodeus directly. I glanced at Jung Heewon, still shielded by the 'Exposed Bush', and spoke.

[Yes. Let's finish this, Asmodeus.]

The power of [□□] surged. The world began to lose its color. Despite the lingering backlash, the Recorder's authority allowed me to override the local probability.

「The forgotten constellation once again reveals its light in the night sky of the <Star Stream>.」

The legends I had built began to manifest upon my body.

「King of a Kingless World.」

「He Who Opposes the Treacherous.」

「He Who Hunted the King of Calamity.」

「He Who Slayed the Deity of Another World.」

「The Demon King of Salvation.」

Using the knowledge gained from Han Sooyoung, I replicated the status of my former self.

「The constellation of the 'Demon King of Salvation' is etched into the abyssal firmament.」

[Your 'Giant Story' responds to your will!]

The original form was Narrative-grade, but now, I was drawing out power that rivaled the pinnacle of that status. If I synchronized my other abilities—

[The constellation, 'Demon King of Salvation', descends upon the battlefield!]

The battlefield fell silent. A voice whispered from the shadows of a nearby constellation.

[Is he... is he also a Myth-grade?]

In terms of pure weight, I was no longer inferior to the entities before me. However, Asmodeus's expression shifted into something unsettling.

【You...】

It wasn't just shock; it was something closer to pity.

【Have you been recording 'yourself' this entire time?】

"What if I have?"

【Do you not know why Recorders never record themselves?】

I paused. I didn't need [Lie Detection] to feel the weight of his words.

【Recorders must never [Record] their own existence. No one who values their soul would dare. If you continue to use that power, you will eventually lose the very thing you are trying to save. You have broken the ultimate taboo...】

For the first time, Asmodeus was speaking a fundamental truth.

【In the end, you will be erased from the 'Final Records'.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 977 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (9)

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After a brief silence, I asked.

[What exactly does that mean?]

It wasn't simply because I was puzzled by his question. Right now, I needed to buy time.

【It means exactly what it sounds like. A recorder who records himself cannot be included in the 'Final Record'.】

That couldn't be true. I had seen recorders document themselves before. The 'Unchanging One' was the prime example.

【I know what you're thinking. But think carefully. What is the true purpose of 'records' and 'recorders'?】

[What are you trying to say?]

【You are different from other recorders. You are the one who seeks to record this world while simultaneously executing its scenarios.】

[So?]

【Characters have their roles, writers have their roles, and readers have their roles.】

I held my breath. I never expected to hear such fundamental logic from Asmodeus.

【If one being occupies all those spaces, how can the story flow properly?】

I thought I understood his point. Ultimately, a story must flow into empty space. If one being occupies every role, the story has nowhere to go.

【Reflect on your path. If you want to survive this entire story, so be it.】

I stared at the empty space of the skill—[□□]—that flickered before my eyes. The void was beautiful, alluring, and terrifyingly distant. It was a blank space that seemed to suck one in if stared at for too long. On that blank canvas, I had written countless sentences. Sometimes I wrote words of encouragement; sometimes, I wrote of someone's death.

「I knew that every time I used this power to record myself, the price was fundamentally wrong.」

The blank space rippled as if it would swallow me at any moment.

「What does it truly mean to record myself?」

Is it even possible to record oneself in a novel? Is the recorded 'me' even 'me'? No, in the first place—

「Who exactly is 'I'?」

As if trying to settle those questions, I finally spoke.

[It doesn't matter.]

【What?】

[If you were going to stop because of a few words, you wouldn't have become a recorder in the first place.]

Asmodeus chuckled, as if he had expected that much.

【Well, I suppose that's why even the Black Flame Dragon was so captivated by you.】

[What do you mean?]

Instead of answering immediately, Asmodeus lowered his head to look at the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon. Within the achromatic field of vision, the dragon was breathing in

slow, heavy rasps.

【Aren't you curious? Why did the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' end up like this?】

[At this point, it seems you were the one who succeeded only with your tongue.]

Asmodeus seemed determined to prolong the standoff. I could guess his intentions.

「An ancient story has begun to boil within the Black Flame Dragon.」

Asmodeus was using a 'crest' to prepare for a second attack. Having sensed that I, too, could wield 'myth-grade' status, he was likely preparing a strike to wipe me and the constellations out in one sweep. But I, too, needed time.

「It is difficult to defeat the Black Flame Dragon with my current strength alone.」

I could sense the Sun Hunter's gaze from afar.

「The Sun Hunter's new arrows will soon be loaded.」

Even for the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', it wouldn't be easy to resist the 'Ten Fingers of God' a second time. If my prediction was correct, the arrow he was preparing would be something special.

「Whichever of us finishes 'preparing' first will hold the hilt.」

I spoke, masking the truth.

[Stop talking nonsense and leave the Black Flame Dragon alone. I don't know what tricks you're using to manipulate him, but—]

【Manipulation? Do you believe I used some nefarious scheme to make him this way?】

[Otherwise, he wouldn't have changed like that.]

A gloomy, destructive aura flowed from the dragon's entire body. The story at its core conveyed the dragon's emotions in real time. I carefully identified that feeling.

「A profound sense of loss.」

I didn't know what the Black Flame Dragon had lost. However, Asmodeus held something over him, and as a result, the dragon had fallen into madness.

[Did you steal from him?]

Even as I asked, I didn't expect a straight answer. Both of us were just stalling for time.

【Why do you think I stole from him?】

Unexpectedly, Asmodeus's expression turned serious.

【If I leave him here like you did, he'll completely collapse. The only reason he can carry out the scenario now is because of my 'record'.】

[…]

【Poor Black Flame Dragon. Looking at his expression right now, I can't even imagine how sad he must be.】

I knew this was Asmodeus's trap. I shouldn't ask any more questions. But the moment he spoke, the question escaped me.

【Don't you really know? He became like this because of you.】

[What nonsense is that? I've never had proper contact with the 'Black Flame Dragon' in this worldline.]

The smile on Asmodeus's face deepened.

【As you know, many strange things have happened in this worldline.】

The moment he spoke, an ominous feeling washed over me.

【Those who shouldn't have intervened have interfered with the scenario, and in return, this worldline has been completely distorted.】

Even though I thought it was impossible to draw, a plot twist was already forming in my head.

「How did the Black Flame Dragon obtain 'myth-grade' power?」

Even as the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', he couldn't have attained mythical status without the 'Great War of Good and Evil' and the protection of the Apocalypse Dragon. However, I knew of one possible plot.

【If you're curious, read it yourself.】

[The story, 'Heir of the Eternal Name', warns you!]

My story was screaming at me. It told me I shouldn't read that—that if I did, I'd never be able to return to who I was. Nevertheless, I reached out to the dragon. As if responding to my gesture, sentences filled with pitch-black blanks began to flow toward me.

—Kim Dokja.

I closed my eyes, and the dragon's voice reached me. But it wasn't calling for me.

—Where are you?

I knew who the Black Flame Dragon was calling.

「In the universe I know, the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' had already reached the power of a mythical constellation.」

The great disaster of the 1,864th round. An ancient story was challenging me.

—Aren't you going to tell me more?

In the deep darkness, his story began to project. The Black Flame Dragon I knew well. The star that contracted with Han Sooyoung and continued the scenario with <Kim Dokja Company>.

—Tell me more.

The dragon in the story roared. Having gained the power of the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse', he was fighting the 'Nameless Mist'.

—Tell me your story isn't over yet.

The Black Flame Dragon was there. With Uriel and the Great Sage, he danced passionately on the stage created by humans. I watched him from the audience. Then, an audience member standing next to me spoke.

—Why do I look so happy over there?

Another Black Flame Dragon stood there. I tried to answer with a blank expression, but then my eyes met the dragon on stage.

—There you were.

A chill ran down my spine as the stage lights went out. In the darkness, Asmodeus asked:

【Do you now understand what you have done?】

All beings move in pursuit of their favorite stories. Just as Uriel and <Kim Dokja Company> did. And perhaps the 1,864th round's 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' came to this worldline just like them.

「Because Kim Dokja began writing a new story.」

He possessed himself in this worldline and observed my story.

【Now, look. The monster of this worldline you created.】

I gazed at the dragon before me. He was the 41st round's 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', but also the 1,864th round's. But the laws of this world do not permit such an 'overlapping of beings'.

「The broken film theory.」

Not all constellations were as fortunate as Uriel. Worldlines overlapped, souls mingled, and for some, their very existences became entangled.

「What becomes of a star that has seen the end of the 'story' it longed to reach? Will they be happy, or will they be saddened that the entire journey was taken away?」

Thus, the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon became a Mad Dragon.

【Kim Dokja, do you think the romance you envision is still a memory everyone longs for?】

From beyond the records, the 'Demon King of the Cinema' spoke.

【Do you naively believe that by recalling those memories, you and <Kim Dokja Company> will reach the grand house of your dreams?】

Asmodeus continued to mock me.

【Those trapped in memories will perish while holding onto them. You will witness their destruction and face the destined end of this world.】

As if issuing a banishing order, the breath of the Abyss began to form in the dragon's maw. To my surprise, his breath had already recharged.

【So, please remain calm and be defeated.】

Embrace the things you cannot change and writhe in sorrow. As if possessed, I approached the Black Flame Dragon. The smile on Asmodeus's face deepened. I placed my hand on the dragon's massive body.

[The stories of the constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', are responding to you!]

The stories that had driven him to madness began to entangle themselves in my fingertips.

[I already know that this world is not normal.]

Asmodeus's eyes wavered at my calm voice. Sensing the dragon's stories, I continued.

[I also know that some people can never be saved, and some stories cannot be changed.]

The dragon looked down at me. I began to pull out the thorns embedded in its body, one by one. With each thorn removed, the dragon flinched and roared.

【What are you doing, Kim Dokja?】

Asmodeus growled.

【This is nonsense. Even if it’s you, do you think you can handle the madness of a myth-grade constellation?】

The thorns began to flow into my body. The dragon's memories ran wild, crushing my blood vessels and tearing through my muscles. I took them in with my whole body. Thorns poured out from my mouth, and my legs shook. Yet, I endured.

[The exclusive trait, 'Understander of the Abyss', aids your understanding.]

With each thorn removed, the dragon's gaze changed. His eyes, once plagued by madness, returned to a calming crimson. The breath he had been preparing dissipated.

「The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon grew by devouring the hearts of the twelve Demon Kings…」

「The madness of overlapping worldlines corrupted the dragon's mind…」

「The roar of a mythical dragon, unstoppable by anything…」

Asmodeus's hastily added words descended upon the dragon. The moment the Black Flame Dragon moved to shake me off, I whispered.

[I'm sorry.]

I held onto his massive frame and unleashed [Incite].

[I'm sorry for making you read the story alone.]

The 'Kim Dokja' speaking these words was not the one the dragon hoped for. And the dragon listening was not the one I remembered.

[I'm sorry I couldn't tell you the story you loved.]

I don't know who I am, but I must continue this story.

[Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, this story is not a burden you should bear. So from now on—]

Because this is the only way to understand who we are.

[I will record you.]

With a roar that made the world creak, the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' stopped moving.

【Kim Dokja!】

I saw Asmodeus rushing towards me, his expression terrified. He was forced to materialize and use physical force, but it was too late.

「The Sun Hunter's strike is finally ready.」

Because my sentence was finally complete.

「The Fourth Finger of the Emperor—'The Ring Finger That Breaks All Bonds'.」

As if he had been waiting, the Sun Hunter released his bow.

【Damn it! Stop—!】

This arrow's power was the power to interfere with the absolute 'promises' of the <Star Stream>.

[Get out of here, Asmodeus.]

In other words, this arrow could temporarily sever all bonds existing within the <Star Stream>.

「Even a sacred 'record contract'.」

The arrow, flying like a flash, pierced Asmodeus' heart.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 978 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (10)

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Asmodeus's eyes were etched with pure disbelief. The white arrow of the divine being, still buried in his chest, pulsed with a blinding radiance as it unleashed its intended authority.

[The effect of the sacred relic, 'Ten Fingers of God', is activated!]

The strike was an undeniable success. Yet, seeing Asmodeus's bewildered expression and hearing the tremor in his voice, a cold sense of foreboding washed over me.

【How could this... happen...】

It was Asmodeus. Could that twisted Demon King, the architect of the Cinema and a veteran of the records, truly have been caught so completely off guard?

【...Did you truly expect me to say that?】

I knew it. Asmodeus glanced toward Hou Yi, who was watching from the horizon, before shifting his gaze back to me.

【I commend the effort. Using the Emperor's arrow to sever my tether... it was a quintessentially Kim Dokja-like strategy.】

[I'll take the compliment, but it isn't what I'm looking for right now.]

Asmodeus’s entire presence began to vibrate with a sinister frequency. Despite the arrow piercing his origin, he showed no sign of agony. Instead, he gripped the shaft with a steady hand, his eyes locking onto mine with an intense, predatory focus.

【However, this is not enough to stop the record.】

[The constellations of the nebula, <Emperor>, are astonished by the resilience of the Great Recorder!]

I was reminded once more why he was the 'Recorder of Fear'. Even other recorders trembled at his name.

【Borrowing the power of others will never bring you the conclusion you crave.】

His words weren't even imbued with [Incite], yet each one felt like an arrow of its own, piercing through my mental defenses.

【If you truly wish to be Kim Dokja, you must not hesitate. You must learn to interpret, destroy, and deny the world with a violence greater than anything you have read.】

For a moment, his face looked strangely mournful. Beneath the mocking facade, I sensed a simmering, ancient rage. Just as my own emotions were inextricably tied to Kim Dokja’s, Asmodeus held a chaotic mass of feelings within him that had never been fully recorded—a melting pot of unwritten grief.

The sentences overflowing from his status began to suppress the light of Di Ku.

「The one who had stepped beyond the boundaries of history to conquer death itself stood before me.」

Even I had to admire his sheer tenacity. If even the Emperor's arrows couldn't subdue him, what options were left? Would I truly have to face the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon in a fight to the death? Could I even pull off the 'Great King of Fear' form in my current state?

【Even if it were me. In the end, you—】

Asmodeus’s voice faltered. A faint sound echoed through the achromatic field.

「...」

It was thin, like the buzzing of an insect or the distant chirp of a bird. No. As I listened closer, the sound took on a heart-wrenching clarity.

「...」

It was the cry of a child. Asmodeus's brow furrowed as he glared into the empty air.

【Are you truly trying to interrupt me now?】

「...」

【Even you... at a time like this...】

「...」

Who was he talking to? His expression shifted rapidly—from anger to frustration, and finally, to a weary resignation.

A strange premonition gripped me. Was he actually talking to that being?

【Yes, I understand. Enough. Silence.】

「...」

【I couldn't help it. Even a recorder has a heart. Especially the incarnation body of that dragon, whom I once...】

The murmur echoed one last time, and Asmodeus let out a heavy, defeated sigh.

【Fine. I will leave the Black Dragon behind. I have no choice.】

Asmodeus's incarnation body began to blur, losing its definition. He was voluntarily withdrawing from the stage.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Demon King of the Cinema', has suffered a critical blow and is exiting the scenario!]

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Demon King of the Cinema', has redacted his own records, mitigating some of the penalty!]

[The effect of the 'Ten Fingers of God' temporarily severs the contract between the Recorder and the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon!]

I reached out as he faded.

[Asmodeus!]

His inscription manifested before my eyes one last time.

「Asmodeus offered a leisurely smile, as if delivering the perfect exit line for a villain.」

【Kim Dokja, do not let this myth-grade status go to your head. Your true enemy is already orchestrating the end of this world, far beyond your reach.】

[...]

【Fight to the bitter end with that masterful tongue of yours. I truly wonder... what sentence will eventually mark your death?】

He vanished completely, leaving only a faint afterimage that slipped through my fingers.

【I leave the Black Flame Dragon in your care—for the time being.】

The moment he disappeared, a deluge of messages erupted in my mind.

[Your monumental achievements resonate across the <Star Stream>!]

[You have acquired a new 'Mythical Story'!]

[The Administration Bureau is deeply moved by your rapid growth!]

[Several Great Dokkaebis have requested a 'Private Meeting' with you!]

[Various nebulae invite you to participate in the 'Context of the Constellation'!]

[The Recorders of Fear are searching the 'Records Archive' for your history!]

[You have been granted a temporary 'Recording Contract'!]

[You are now the acting Recorder for the constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon'!]

「Yes. You are finally coming.」

I must have lost consciousness for a few minutes. When the world finally stopped spinning, I felt someone roughly shaking my shoulder.

"Kim Dokja!"

Anna Croft's face was ashen. She was gripping my shoulder with enough force to crack the bone.

"It... it hurts, Anna."

"Are you awake?"

"Yes. I'm fine. Mostly."

I gently pried her hand away. My shoulder felt like it had been through a hydraulic press. Anna supported my weight as I tried to steady my breathing.

"Are you certain you're alright?"

"Yeah. What about Asmodeus?"

"Asmodeus?"

I realized she didn't know his true name. In this worldline, he was only known by the title 'Demon King of the Cinema'. I didn't have the energy to explain the complex history of the 1,864th round.

"What about the Black Flame Dragon?"

Anna pointed toward the ground. There, curled into a defensive posture, lay the pitch-black form of the dragon.

[The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon's complete descent has been terminated.]

With Asmodeus's probability withdrawn, the dragon had lost its anchor. It was dispersing slowly, its presence no longer justified by the scenario's rules.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', is looking at you.]

I felt a strange, hollow longing in that message. I couldn't tell which version of him was looking at me—the one from the 41st round or the one I remembered—but the goodwill was unmistakable.

"Dokja-ssi!"

Jung Heewon had emerged from the 'Exposed Bush' and was rushing toward us. She checked my face with frantic eyes.

"Are you okay? Where are you hurt?"

"I'm fine, Heewon-ssi. Are you safe?"

"I'm alright. But... how did you do it? That dragon looked like it was going to destroy the world, but the moment you stood in its way, it just... stopped."

[Several constellations wish to hear the details of your feat!]

I couldn't exactly explain that I'd just had a high-stakes debate with a primal demon king.

"I just held his attention for a while. A staring contest, you could say."

[Some constellations are moved by your indomitable spirit!]

[You have acquired a new story!]

[You have acquired the mythical story, 'Adversary of the Dragon'!]

[You have acquired the legendary story, 'Master of the Staring Contest'!]

'Adversary of the Dragon' was a rare prize, usually reserved for those who survived the Apocalypse scenarios. The staring contest one was... well, a bonus.

But the peace didn't last.

"Kim Dokja!"

Anna Croft's voice was sharp with warning. I turned to see the surrounding constellations closing in. These were the hunters of the various nebulae who had been lurking, waiting for the myths to exhaust each other.

「To stop the dragon, I had effectively summoned every predator in the region to my location.」

The real battle was only just beginning. Every star here wanted a piece of a Myth-grade target. The first to step forward were the Narrative-grade stalkers from <Papyrus>.

[The constellation, 'Black Wolf Reaper', unleashes its status!]

The air grew thick with aggression, but the constellations held back, eyeing each other warily. No one wanted to be the first to draw the 'Demon King of Salvation's' ire.

[Demon King of Salvation.]

It was Anubis, the Black Wolf Reaper, who spoke first.

[I have come to collect you. Join <Papyrus>.]

The arrogance was staggering. Even Olympus had learned to tread carefully around me.

"And if I decline?"

I still held the status of my 'Demon King' form. I wasn't about to bow to a wolf just because he was baring his teeth. Anubis didn't seem surprised.

[You are free to refuse, of course.]

His eyes shifted away from me, settling on Jung Heewon and Anna Croft. Both women tensed instantly. Anubis hadn't given up; he had simply changed his leverage.

[However, <Papyrus> will remember this decision. We have a very long memory.]

I felt a cold smile touch my lips. It wasn't exactly a subtle threat. I gripped my scepter, weighing my options. I was outnumbered, and my stories were fraying.

「Can I protect them both if I unleash the 'Great King of Fear' now?」

I was prepared to pay the price, but then—

[Step back, Anubis.]

A giant wreathed in light stepped between us.

[An announcement is issued to all constellations present!]

Mitra, despite his tattered wings and broken status, stood as a shield before me.

[If you lay a hand on the Demon King of Salvation, you will answer to me.]

He was still a Myth-grade constellation. There wasn't a Narrative-grade being on the field willing to gamble their life against him. Anubis snarled, his teeth clicking together.

[We withdraw.]

As the <Papyrus> forces retreated into the shadows, the other constellations followed suit. They had realized that, for today, I was untouchable. Mitra turned back to me once

the field was clear.

[Demon King of Salvation.]

I faced him, my guard still up. He was a constellation of <Vedas>, after all. They were just as greedy as the rest. But instead of an attack, the massive entity slowly lowered himself onto one knee.

[I offer my sincere respects to you.]

The staff of the Golden Dice Hall followed his lead, prostrating themselves in the dirt.

[The constellation, 'Lord of December 25th', pays its respects!]

[The constellations of the Golden Dice Hall offer their tribute!]

It was a surreal sight. The records of the 'Unchanging One' flickered in my mind. This was the moment—the formal recognition of the 'Demon King of Salvation' as a true Myth-grade existence by the Master of Valhalla.

My heart hammered in my chest. I felt a tectonic shift in the rules of my reality.

「This universe is nothing more than a game of dice played by the gods.」

The world felt suddenly distant, a dizzying sensation pulling at my soul, much like when I had first ascended.

「And in that great game, he has finally earned his own dice.」

[You have earned the right to participate in the 'Round Table of Myths'!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 979 Episode 58 Myth-grade Constellation (11)

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The Mythical Circle.

When I first reached the status of 'Mythical', I briefly glimpsed its impossible landscape. But back then, I didn't truly feel like a part of that world. I was a mere visitor—an observer who could witness its scenery but lacked the authority to interfere with its events.

[This is likely the greatest gift I can offer you now.]

A die of iridescent hues ascended from Mitra's right hand, radiating a brilliance that pierced through the gloom.

[The constellation, 'Lord of December 25th', has transferred his 'Dice of Destiny' to you!]

The die traced a line of light through the air and settled firmly into my palm. The sensation was unsettlingly familiar, as if it had belonged to me from the very beginning. I knew exactly what it represented.

「Mitra has transferred his seat at the 'Round Table of Myths' to me.」

This 'die' was my invitation—my ticket into the Round Table of Mythology.

[When a star reaches the level of myth, they possess a crystal of their own story, condensed to its absolute limit.]

I belatedly realized the true identity of the die spinning in my hand. It was a fragment of a legend, forged at the very moment Mitra first ascended to the status of a Myth.

[You did not attain Mythology through the path of a 'constellation', so you never received your own. Therefore, take mine.]

A low rumble of thunder rolled through the artificial sky as Mitra made his declaration.

[Some constellations are moved by the decision of the 'Lord of December 25th'!]

[The constellations of the nebula, <Vedas>, strongly contest the judgment of the 'Lord of December 25th'!]

Mitra looked up at the firmament. Immediately, the heavens fell into a terrified silence.

[The constellation, 'Lord of December 25th', reveals his true nature!]

[The constellations of <Vedas> obey the will of the 'Lord of December 25th'.]

He was a being capable of enforcing his own will, even in defiance of a Great Nebula.

What I had now received was the concentrated essence of such a mythical entity, carved from the core of his own story.

[The sacred relic, 'Dice of Destiny', has been acquired.]

Mitra, having surrendered the die, wore a complex expression of deep regret and profound relief. I realized that now was the time to seek an honest answer from him.

"Mitra, what exactly is the 'Round Table'? And what purpose do these dice serve?"

Even in 'Ways of Survival', the 'Round Table' was never specifically described. It was only mentioned as a secret banquet hall where the 'mythical constellations' gathered. Since even the original Kim Dokja had never been invited, I was woefully lacking in information.

[The Round Table is the place where the fate of the world is decided. And only those who hold the dice have the right to interfere with that fate.]

Mitra gazed silently at the sky, as if reading the constellations written across the void, and added:

[Only the chosen mythical constellations may enter the Round Table banquet. There, they manipulate the ultimate probability of the <Star Stream>.]

"Is it really alright for you to give me something so significant?"

[It doesn't matter. I have no desire to return to that table. Even if I did, there would be little left for me to do. But for you... it may be different.]

Mitra smiled weakly and began to help his fallen subordinates to their feet. One by one, the constellations of the Golden Dice Hall regained their strength, bolstered by Mitra's grace.

[If you truly seek the ■■ of all these stories, you will eventually have to pass through that hall.]

He spoke with a weariness so heavy that the entire scene felt like a retirement ceremony.

"Are you no longer curious about your own ■■?"

[Is there any constellation that does not wonder about the end?]

"Then why give me the dice?"

Every star exists only to reach the final conclusion of all stories. Born for that purpose, they cannot help but exist for it.

Yet Mitra had just laid down the only tool that would allow him to participate in that final gamble.

[When I first chose to remain in 'Valhalla Hall', many thoughts crossed my mind.]

The harsh radiance emanating from his form had dimmed. He was no longer using coercion; he was simply speaking the truth.

[A desire to avenge my defeat. A desire to punish the 'Round Table' for discarding me. I wanted to shake the Star Stream once more by becoming the center of a new legend.]

"And now?"

Through the die, I could vaguely sense the weight of Mitra's history.

Mitra, who had lost his duel with 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' and was relegated to the master of 'Valhalla Hall'. I saw the history of a god who managed the lesser stars and witnessed countless desperate competitions.

After a brief pause, Mitra continued.

[Once you ascend to the level of myth, you stop looking back at trivial stories. Unless it is a Giant Story, you rarely pay attention. You spend all day consumed by a stagnant laziness, reliving your own glory over and over again.]

To complete a world is to close the door to it and become a prisoner. To complete a myth is to imprison oneself within that legend.

In that sense, all the 'myth-grade constellations' at the pinnacle of this world were captives of their own stories.

[While staying in this hall, I was finally forced to look back at the stories of others.]

Amidst that stagnation, an unexpected opportunity had presented itself to him.

[I was imprisoned in Valhalla, but in a sense, I was also liberated from my own narrative. Because I was forced to witness the stories of those beneath me.]

There, Mitra had watched countless incarnations and stars perish in the arena.

[I remember one match in particular. It was a game where a Transcendent appeared.]

"Which Transcendent was it?"

[A famous one. However, it wasn't the Transcendent who caught my eye. It was another incarnation on that team.]

It was a team led by a Transcendent, yet his attention had been drawn not to the powerhouse, but to a different incarnation.

"He must have been exceptionally strong then."

[No, he wasn't as strong as the Transcendent. He wasn't weak, per se, but he lacked the exceptional talent that would normally attract the gaze of a god.]

It was a peculiar admission. An incarnation, neither as strong as a Transcendent nor possessing special genius, had captivated a Myth. Why?

[It was a consistently hopeless match. The enemy team was far too powerful, and the Transcendent's team was decimated in minutes. The Transcendent was surprisingly resilient and put up a desperate fight, but that was all. It was a battle whose outcome was already written.]

The picture was forming in my mind. If a Transcendent of that caliber had lost, their opponent must have been a 'Giant Nebula'.

And even that Transcendent had died in the end.

Even though it was just a retelling of a past match, I felt a pang of regret, wondering if the Transcendent was someone I had once known.

[Still, that incarnation refused to give up.]

"He didn't?"

[He ran desperately, knowing there was no chance of victory.]

"I assume he was searching for the prophecy."

With a prophecy in hand, there is always a chance to turn the tables, no matter how unfavorable the odds. But Mitra shook his head.

[That was beyond his reach. He just kept running, losing an arm, then a leg. One of his eyes was gouged out, and every nerve in his body was charred by lightning.]

Just the description was enough to convey the horrific reality that incarnation had faced. His determination to survive seemed as iron-clad as Yoo Joonghyuk’s.

"Was his tenacity what impressed you?"

[No. Anyone can run when their life is on the line. It is a primal instinct.]

That was true. Everyone values their own existence. Some are overwhelmed by despair and surrender, while others cling to a fraying hope.

But the incarnation in the story wasn't trying to protect his own life.

[He was shielding a child in his one remaining arm.]

I forgot to breathe for a moment, my focus entirely consumed by the narrative.

[As you know, it is not easy to reach Scenario #85 and still fight to protect someone else.]

No matter how noble your start, those who reach Scenario #85 usually have their psyche worn down to nothing. Their emotions are frayed, and they lose the ability to care for anything but themselves.

"I take it the child was his own?"

[No. There was no blood connection between them.]

It was a strange story—a truly bizarre tale, yet one that didn't sound entirely foreign to me.

Because in that moment...

"What happened to that incarnation?"

I already knew who that man was.

[He succeeded.]

My heart hammered against my ribs. "He succeeded." That was how Mitra had phrased it. It was a strange way to describe the outcome of a skirmish, which usually ended in 'victory' or 'defeat'. But Mitra said he 'succeeded'.

[He ran until he broke through the boundaries of the arena. He escaped the prison of the scenario that held him captive.]

A high-pitched ringing echoed in my ears. Finally, unable to contain it, I asked.

"By any chance... was that incarnation's name 'Lee Dansu'?"

Mitra paused, considering the name for a long moment.

[Is he familiar to you?]

I nodded with great difficulty. Suppressing the storm in my chest, I forced out the next question.

"Yes. What happened to him after his escape?"

[I do not know. He vanished beyond the reach of 'Valhalla Hall'.]

I tried my best to steady my breathing. Still, I couldn't mask the raw emotion welling up within me.

「Dansu ahjussi is alive.」

He had fought the constellations, fled, and eventually—with a child in his arms—found the 'Missing Bush' and escaped the skirmish.

[I still recall his response when the enemy constellations asked why he was so protective of that child.]

For a heartbeat, I could almost hear the vivid, gravelly voice of Dansu ahjussi.

「"To you who ask why I must protect this child—even if I told you my reason, you would never understand."」

I felt breathless. It was unmistakable. It was Dansu ahjussi. Even after eight years, he was still the same man I remembered.

[There is a sentence left by the recorder who watched over him until the very end.]

A line of text manifested in the air, pulsing with a faint light.

「Those who protect their hearts to the very end may know the truth of the world without ever seeing its ■■.」

I thought about Dansu ahjussi. A man who had been searching for his daughter, Jiyoon.

His daughter was trapped in Asmodeus's theater. So, if he was protecting a child now... who was it?

[And strangely enough, after reading that man's story, the original values within me changed.]

"Changed?"

[I know it sounds absurd. That a star who has reached the level of myth could suddenly change after reading the story of a single human.]

Mitra continued, speaking as if he knew I wouldn't believe him.

[For a constellation that has lived for eons to change the direction of its light simply by reading a story... even I find it difficult to fathom.]

He was right. This wasn't just true for constellations, but for humans as well. Very few beings have their lives altered by a single narrative.

「And yet, I know full well that such a story is not impossible.」

I already knew of several constellations that had read a story, loved it, and changed the course of their existence because of it.

And Mitra, too, was looking at the stars following him with a gaze similar to the ones I knew. They were the stars gathered in 'Valhalla Hall'.

[Actually, I hadn't made up my mind until then. But now, I have. The other myth-grade constellations may call me a loser or a coward. I don't care. I no longer seek the approval of the Round Table. I don't care if the universe laughs at my choices.]

The stars of the 'Hall of Golden Dice'—stars from countless different nebulae—had decided to abandon their affiliations to follow him.

Mitra looked at them and spoke softly.

[I still wonder about the ■■ of this world. But I have chosen not to be the one who confirms it.]

The dice in my hand vibrated with warmth.

Dansu ahjussi wasn't Kim Dokja. Yet, perhaps, he had accomplished something even more incredible. He had lived his life to the fullest and protected what was precious.

[I intend to escape this '■■' hell with those who follow me. Just as that man once did.]

Ahjussi had succeeded in changing the starlight of a Great Myth.

Mitra, with a faint, knowing smile, spoke as if he already knew my next move.

[Now, I will tell you where the 'Missing Bush' is located.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 980 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (1)

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「This is a story about the 'house'.」

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Mitra immediately disclosed the coordinates of the 'Missing Bush'.

"How did you know I was looking for that specific thicket?"

Mitra offered only a cryptic, lingering smile. In truth, I didn't need a verbal answer to guess the reason. This 'battlefield' was essentially his personal sanctuary. If Mitra truly desired it, he could likely eavesdrop on every vibration of sound within the 'Valhalla Hall'. If his opponent hadn't been Asmodeus and the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, a Myth-grade constellation like Mitra would never have been suppressed so easily.

「The map of the super-large battlefield provided by Mitra etched itself clearly into my mind.」

I offered another bow, grateful for his cooperation. Mitra watched me with a pensive look.

[That is all I can provide. I cannot guarantee that the one you seek remains there.]

"Didn't the incarnation you mentioned earlier escape through that very portal?"

[He did. But even if the exit remains the same, there is no promise that you will arrive at the same destination.]

That was true. An exit is merely a gateway. There was no way to determine which path a previous traveler had taken once they crossed the threshold.

[Above all else, the Missing Bush is a portal anchored by the Wennies. There is no guarantee the exit will be located in a safe zone.]

A portal of the Wennies. For a fleeting moment, I considered reaching out to the Wenny King for assistance, but I quickly discarded the thought. Engaging with a being of that magnitude at this stage would demand a price I wasn't prepared to pay.

"I forgot to ask earlier, but when you spoke of escaping the 'Hell of ■■', was that meant as a metaphor?"

Mitra hesitated, the question seemingly catching him off guard.

[You are aware that such a blunt inquiry is considered rude among our kind, aren't you?]

I was belatedly reminded of a specific trait common among Myth-grade entities.

「Constellations who have ascended to 'Myth' status possess a chronic tendency toward equivocation.」

While speaking in riddles is a standard idiom for constellations, the Myth-grade ones were the worst offenders.

「"Those bastards always speak in metaphors and allusions. That's how they keep themselves free from the binding force of their own [Declarations]."」

In a world constructed entirely of stories, the words of a Great Being carry immense narrative weight. Han Sooyoung had once explained that Myth-grade stars must be masters of rhetoric and ambiguity to avoid being trapped by their own promises.

「"It is their nature to misinterpret others as they see fit. That is why you must pin them down with clear, direct language."」

I ignored Mitra's discomfort and decided to stick to Han Sooyoung's strategy.

"I'm a 'T' type personality, so I'm a bit sensitive to vague phrasing."

[T? What is this 'T'?]

It was a throwaway comment; I'd never actually taken an MBTI test.

"It simply means we should avoid using language that is unnecessarily difficult to parse."

[...]

"What you said sounded like a formal declaration of your intent to abandon this scenario. Therefore, I assume you intend to use the Missing Bush. Am I interpreting you correctly?"

[I am... considering the possibility.]

Unlike the legendary Lee Dansu, who had declared his escape from the 'Hell of ■■' with a stirring mantra, Mitra's expression remained frustratingly ambiguous. I understood his caution and allowed a small smile.

"Good. Then I suppose I'll be accompanying you to that bush."

Mitra's eyes widened as he realized my intent, a flicker of genuine admiration crossing his face.

[I truly admire the weight of that tongue of yours.]

"I'll take that as a compliment."

If I was going to establish a cooperative bond with Mitra, it was better to keep him close until we actually reached the thicket. With a Myth-grade constellation as a traveling companion, Papyrus and the other lingering predators would think twice before approaching. Of course, my motives weren't entirely selfless.

「If the situation turns dire, I can let Mitra enter the 'Missing Bush' first.」

As he had pointed out, the safety of the portal was unverified. Sending a Myth-grade entity in as a scout would be an effective improvisation. He was the Master of the Resurrection Festival, after all; he wouldn't perish easily even if the other side of the portal was a trap. Mitra gave me a sharp, suspicious look, as if he could sense the gears turning in my head, but I maintained a mask of perfect innocence.

"By the way, how exactly am I supposed to use these dice?"

[You will know the moment the 'Round Table' convenes.]

"And when will that be?"

[That...]

The moment he tried to answer, a violent cluster of sparks wreathed his entire body.

[It appears the 'Round Table' does not wish for me to speak on the matter.]

I briefly wondered if he was faking the backlash to avoid the question, but it was a waste of energy to press a being who had no intention of answering.

"Then there's no issue with us traveling together, right?"

[None. However, there is a lingering matter I must address first.]

A matter to address? I followed Mitra's gaze and realized I had forgotten something—or someone. About twenty paces away, a lone constellation from a major nebula still loomed.

[Child of <Emperor>, do you still intend to challenge me?]

It was Hou Yi, the Sun Hunter. He remained standing, his massive red bow held steady, glaring in our direction with an unblinking gaze. Mitra frowned, clearly annoyed by his presence.

[If you continue this insolence...]

"Wait a moment."

I held Mitra back and approached the Sun Hunter. Even as I entered his immediate striking range, Hou Yi didn't react. I waved a hand experimentally in front of his face. His pupils didn't even twitch.

"He's out cold?"

It made sense. The White Arrows of the Emperor demanded a staggering amount of probability with every use. In particular, the 'Fourth Finger' he had fired was an arrow that placed an exponential burden on the user based on the 'rank' of the target. Since he had interfered with a 'Recording Contract' involving both a Mythical Constellation and a high-ranking Recorder, the backlash must have been catastrophic. The other <Emperor> constellations had either fled or been annihilated in the previous clash. Seeing the legendary Sun Hunter standing there unconscious in character pajamas was an absurd sight. Then, my eyes drifted to the White Arrow still clutched in his hand.

Wait a minute. Could I actually...?

"I truly wonder what goes on inside that head of yours."

Anna Croft sounded as though she had run out of the capacity for surprise.

"You haven't forgotten who he is, have you? He is the Chairman of Valhalla."

"I'm well aware."

Regardless of his current eloquence, Mitra was the one responsible for the hundreds of deaths Anna Croft had suffered in the previous rounds.

"Do you honestly believe you can trust a being like that?"

"Is there any constellation in this world truly worth trusting?"

I glanced back at Mitra, who was currently tending to his subordinates. He was pretending to be occupied, but I knew he was using his status to eavesdrop.

"He has his own agenda, and I have mine. It's a mutually beneficial arrangement. Don't overthink it."

Sensing my skepticism toward the god, Anna’s expression softened slightly.

"What are you doing now?"

"Oh, this?"

I was currently in the middle of rubbing the 'Ten Fingers of God'—which I'd pilfered from the catatonic Hou Yi—against the 'Thoughts of Almost Everything'.

[Item: 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' — Mimicry Proficiency is increasing!]

Normally, it was nearly impossible for 'Thought' to mimic a relic of this caliber. However, the item had evolved significantly. Now, even a Mythical-grade artifact was within its reach.

[Item: 'Thoughts of Almost Everything' — Mimicry is progressing rapidly!]

The specific condition for this 'Mimicry Form' was 'rubbing the item one thousand times'. It was a tedious but effective requirement.

[The sacred relic, 'Ten Fingers of God', emits a faint, pained hum!]

As expected of a relic belonging to the Five Emperors, the arrows vibrated in my hand with every pass. I ignored the tingling sensation and kept going. Finally...

['Mimicry Form' successfully acquired!]

A completion message flashed in my vision. At that exact moment, Hou Yi gasped, his consciousness returning with a jolt.

[Ugh!]

His eyes snapped to the relic in my hand, his expression turning sharp.

[What are you doing with that?]

"Just admiring the craftsmanship. It's a remarkable piece."

I was effectively stealing the data of his soul's weapon. I gave him a shameless smile and handed the 'Ten Fingers of God' back. Hou Yi took the arrow, inspecting it with a bewildered look.

[How were you even able to hold this? This relic is designed to reject anyone but a permitted wielder.]

Standard procedure for high-level artifacts. The 'Ten Fingers of God' possessed the 'Thousand-Year Interrogation', a passive curse that inflicted excruciating psychological agony on unauthorized users. For me, however, it was a non-factor.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', is active!]

Hou Yi, unaware of my immunity, looked at me with newfound respect.

[Perhaps the Emperor holds you in higher regard than I thought. To think he would allow you to touch his 'fingers'...]

In reality, I had just committed a form of narrative larceny by rubbing my 'Thought' all over his arrows. Fortunately, the actual Emperor seemed too preoccupied with the higher scenarios to notice someone playing with his gear.

"Anyway, what happened to the rest of your group?"

[My group?]

"The ones who arrived with you."

Hou Yi scanned the ruined horizon.

[Most have fled. Others were likely repatriated to the higher scenarios. A general recall order was issued during the fighting.]

A return order?

[There is a crisis unfolding in the upper tiers. An emergency summons was broadcast to all high-ranking units.]

I didn't know the specifics, but it was clear that something monumental was happening on the main battlefield.

"Regardless, thank you for the intervention. I wouldn't have survived Asmodeus without you."

I was being sincere. Fighting Asmodeus and a berserk dragon simultaneously would have been a death sentence. Hou Yi accepted the thanks with practiced indifference.

[I had my own motives. It was merely a coincidence that our interests aligned.]

"Do you still intend to deliver me to <Emperor>?"

[I have no such intention.]

"Wasn't that your primary mission?"

Hou Yi blinked, then slowly shook his head.

[If a contract is not paid, there is no obligation to fulfill it. My term was the location of my Transcendent comrades. You have yet to provide that information.]

I had fully intended to keep my word, but his bluntness was refreshing.

"Right. I'll tell you what I know."

Since we had a few minutes before moving toward the Missing Bush, I briefed him on the Transcendents I had encountered. I started with the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, Namgung Minyeong—covering the events in the Realm of Fear, the New Murim District, and the 'World Tree Project' the constellations had attempted to force on her.

[I see. So she was there...]

Hou Yi listened with rapt attention, his expression fluctuating between sorrow and fury. His emotional transparency was surprising; Jung Heewon, who had been listening nearby, finally spoke up.

"Are you truly a friend of the Master?"

[I'd like to believe so. Though she might have a different opinion.]

His tone was uncharacteristically humble. Jung Heewon, meeting someone who actually remembered the Sword Saint with such clarity for the first time, took over the storytelling. She filled in the details I had missed. Hou Yi nodded solemnly, his empathy for the Transcendents palpable.

[So, her story now resides with you?]

"It does."

[That explains the resonance I felt when I first saw you...]

Hou Yi gazed at me with a look of profound longing before composing himself.

[And what of Kyrgios and Cheok Jungyeong?]

"I don't have all the details. But I know Master Kyrgios has already ascended to the 'Main Battlefield'."

[As I expected.]

He seemed to have anticipated as much.

"Do you plan to find him?"

[The end of the world is approaching. I should like to share one final glass with my friends before the starlight fades.]

It was startling to find a constellation within a nebula like <Emperor> who was driven by such romantic notions as friendship. I asked him sincerely:

"If you find them... could you let me know?"

Hou Yi nodded without hesitation.

[I will. It is destiny that I met my friend's successor. Kyrgios and Jungyeong would be proud of what you've become.]

"I doubt that."

With that, my discussions with both Mitra and Hou Yi concluded. All that remained was the journey to the Missing Bush. I was about to ask if the Sun Hunter would join us when he spoke in a low, sharp voice.

[What do you intend to do about that?]

That? I followed his line of sight.

[If you wish, I can sever its tether here and now.]

I quickly moved to stop him as he reached for his bow.

"No, that won't be necessary."

In the direction he was aiming, the gargantuan form of the Black Flame Dragon had yet to fully dissipate. I wasn't sure why the descent was lingering, but provoking it further was a bad idea.

[Why? That beast intended to erase you.]

"It wasn't his will. Not truly."

[Not his will? You believe a star's actions can be separated from its intent?]

"In this world, stories determine existence. Sometimes, the story is a lie."

Hou Yi’s eyes sparkled with curiosity.

[You believe the stories are 'wrong'? Do you think the evil or the good narratives he carries do not represent the core of his being?]

I knew that stories didn't account for everything. Actions were the intersection of will and narrative. But I felt a strange need to defend him.

"I don't know the whole truth. But if it's a false record, I might be able to fix it."

As his temporary recorder, I had the authority to interfere with his history. I could use my status to peer into his past and understand why he had become this corrupted entity.

[The stories of the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' are responding to your presence!]

As I approached, the dragon's incarnation body began to dissolve into motes of shadow, as if it had been waiting for me to arrive. I thought it was the end of the encounter, but as the smoke cleared, my heart skipped a beat.

「My breath caught in my throat.」

In the space where the dragon's massive form had stood, lying amidst the fading pitch-black smoke, was a person I knew very well.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 981 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (2)

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Jung Heewon was the first to speak.

"Huh?"

Jung Heewon leaped through the swirling black dragon smoke, shielding me, and then asked with a suspicious expression.

"Isn't… that him?"

I nodded. He clearly didn't look like the guy I knew. But there, where the black dragon's massive body had disappeared, was undoubtedly 'Kim Namwoon'.

「To be more precise, it was something close to 'Kim Namwoon'.」

No matter how I looked at him, he appeared to be a young boy, barely ten years old. Yet, the child's face still held the nuance of the 'Kim Namwoon' that Jung Heewon and I remembered.

I quickly pushed through the smoke and carefully picked up Kim Namwoon, who was sprawled on the ground.

「I've seen characters who have become 'kkomas' like this before.」

The shattered Kim Dokja, and even the Secretive Plotter who had overused his probability, had been reduced to kkomas. Was Kim Namwoon in a similar situation?

Jung Heewon asked in a worried voice.

"What could have happened to him?"

"He likely suffered the aftermath of summoning the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon'."

The 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' was now a constellation of mythical status. It should have been impossible for an incarnation to even borrow his power, let alone summon his full descent.

But Kim Namwoon had performed a miracle, pulling the black dragon's massive form into his own body. It occurred to me then that Kim Namwoon, the Delusion Demon, was a comrade of Yoo Joonghyuk who had rightfully earned his place in the 『Top 100 Strongest』.

"Ah."

Kim Namwoon slowly opened his eyes in my arms. Drenched in cold sweat, he looked up from within my embrace and pursed his lips several times.

Ah. Ah. Ah.

I felt a wave of dizziness. What came out was not his own voice. The man's words, vomited from deep within his lungs, pierced right through me.

「"I only follow the captain's orders. And you... you aren't the captain."」

Kim Namwoon's voice, engulfed in a fierce black flame, was followed by a detached reply that felt chillingly familiar.

「"Of course. You aren't needed on 'that stage' anyway."」

The moment I heard that voice, my heart sank.

'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

It was unmistakable. This was a memory of Kim Namwoon confronting my brother.

But I couldn't understand it. Why had Kim Namwoon stood against him? And why had my brother deemed Kim Namwoon 'unnecessary'?

「What on earth is this 'stage' that Snowfield Kim Dokja is speaking of?」

What I knew for certain was that 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was responsible for Kim Namwoon's current state. It was one more reason I had to meet my brother.

"Dokja-ssi!"

The volume of stories flowing from Kim Namwoon was increasing steadily. As the narratives overflowed violently, I could feel his body gradually shrinking. If this continued, Kim Namwoon would completely disintegrate and vanish from this world.

「【I'll leave the Black Flame Dragon to you 'for the time being'.】」

Is that why Asmodeus said that? That bastard was planning to leave me with the exhausting work.

[You are currently the recorder of the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon'.]

I took a deep breath and began to gather Kim Namwoon's scattered stories.

Stories possess an inherent resilience; if the shattered fragments can be kept from scattering completely, they can be restored.

The problem was how to anchor the fragments that had already lost their cohesion.

「It's okay.」

I began speaking to Kim Namwoon as if I were truly talking to him. I could feel his shoulders tremble as he continued to regress into a child. Just saying it's okay wouldn't fix him instantly—I knew that. All I could do was offer a different story to someone trapped in a nightmare.

「There is an ending to every universe.」

One effective way to maintain the unity of a narrative is to plant 'another story' to bridge the gaps. By reconnecting the fragments of a broken tale with a different one, you create a new central axis.

「A story that can never be reached, so in some worlds, it is no different from a dream.」

I told Kim Namwoon the story of the 1,863rd round.

「That is Han Sooyoung's story.」

I chose this because the 1,863rd round was the world line where the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' and the 'Water Character' Kim Namwoon survived to see the conclusion.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', is focusing on your records.]

The reason Kim Namwoon's condition was so precarious was ultimately because the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' was unstable.

If I could just hold the black dragon's attention, Kim Namwoon's chances of recovery would rise.

Indeed, as the narrative progressed, his condition improved rapidly. Color returned to his pale cheeks, and the scattered fragments of the narrative began to click back into place.

[The narrative of the 'character' in question is stabilizing.]

As I expected. The 1,863rd round was centered on that 'Han Sooyoung'. Since Han Sooyoung's sponsor in the 1,864th round was the Black Flame Dragon, it was inevitable that he would be drawn to her story.

Just as I thought I could stop recording, Kim Namwoon's lips parted again. This time, it wasn't a moan or a scream. He spoke a name.

"Lee Jihye."

I nodded, showing him I was listening. Kim Namwoon opened his mouth again, his lips trembling.

"Save... Jihye."

For a moment, my mind went blank. I hadn't expected to hear those words from him, of all people.

「That proud Kim Namwoon—the narrow-minded, delusional demon who relied on no one—was asking me for a favor.」

As if he thought I hadn't heard him correctly, he spoke again.

"Save... Yoosung."

Had I ever seen Kim Namwoon ask for anyone's help? Even after writing and reading so many sentences, I still didn't fully understand this story. I felt a sense of bewilderment and a subtle elation at the same time.

「The addition of just one line can change the entire landscape of a story.」

What kind of picture was my brother painting as the world line neared its conclusion? And why was Kim Namwoon excluded from that landscape?

"I will."

I couldn't tell if the fainting Kim Namwoon had heard me.

"Definitely."

However, his closed eyes looked more serene than they had before.

Mitra, who had been observing the situation from a distance, raised his massive form.

[It seems we are ready.]

It was time to set out in search of the 'Missing Bush'.

To cut to the chase, the search for the 'Missing Bush' was not easy.

"I don't think it's here either."

Mitra had marked five potential locations for the 'Missing Bush'.

We had already failed to find it in three of them.

"Is that map actually defective?"

Mitra cleared his throat in response to my question.

[Bushes appear randomly. Even if there is a pattern, it doesn't mean they will always manifest in the exact same spot. We have confirmed three positions; it is certain to appear in one of the remaining two.]

As Mitra spoke, he led his subordinates forward, his massive body swaying. Frankly, I was dissatisfied with our pace, but I wasn't in a position to complain.

「For now, it's safer to move with Mitra.」

Even now, we were being pursued by those a few hundred meters away. They were likely remnants of Papyrus or another giant nebula.

Anna Croft, watching Mitra's sluggish gait, approached me.

"I think we're wasting time."

"He's badly injured. His wings were torn off."

"It's his wings, not his legs. Our progress is too slow. It feels as if he's waiting for something."

Anna Croft spoke with a suspicion that rivaled my own. Jung Heewon, who was carrying Kim Namwoon on her back, joined in.

"I agree. He was a sinister constellation from the start."

I knew Mitra was listening, so I didn't acknowledge it openly, but I wasn't oblivious to their doubts.

Even if Mitra was a mythical constellation, this was a 'super-large battlefield'. With the Round Table potentially intervening and the variable of the 'Black Flame Dragon' looming, maintaining this slow pace suggested a hidden agenda.

[The 'Sanctuary' will appear soon!]

Just then, a message regarding the Sanctuary appeared.

Mitra stopped walking. Several of the constellations escorting him began to whisper in low voices.

「The Sanctuary.」

The Sanctuary was one of the key events of this 'super-large battlefield'.

「When the Sanctuary appears, a five-minute timer begins. After the timer expires, all twenty participants standing within the Sanctuary's light will be transferred to the 'Main Battlefield'.」

Only five minutes. If they could survive five minutes in that zone, they could proceed directly to the 'Main Battlefield'. For the constellations of Valhalla Hall who had been forcibly dragged here, this was a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity.

[Many constellations are awaiting the appearance of the 'Sanctuary'!]

Even though Mitra was holding back, I could sense the number of constellations gathering in the surrounding area increasing rapidly.

[I intend to advance to the higher battlefield from here.]

The Sun Hunter seemed determined to seize the opportunity. While I felt a sense of regret, his goal was to find his transcendent friends; it was only right that we part ways.

"Thank you for everything."

[Be careful.]

It was unclear what exactly he was warning us about. However, for some reason, the Sun Hunter turned his gaze toward Mitra. I followed his look. Sensing our eyes on him, Mitra began to approach. The 'Sanctuary' must have appeared. I thought I was finally about to hear Mitra's plan—

[I found the Missing Bush.]

The unexpected news made me jump. We had finally found it.

But Mitra's expression was grim.

[However, I recommend not entering.]

"Why?"

[The presence of the 'Outer Deity' feels too powerful.]

Outer Deity. Even though I had acquired the power of the 'Fear Realm', an 'Outer Deity' was still a significant burden.

Furthermore, if Mitra, a mythical constellation, described it as 'strong', it wasn't just any deity. It was a natural disaster.

In the worst case, a being equivalent to the 'End-of-the-World' was lingering within those bushes.

「Perhaps a 'Great Old One' is waiting there.」

If a presence of that level existed, even the 'Fear Realm' wouldn't be enough to counter it easily.

But I couldn’t back down. The 'Missing Bush' was my only clue to finding Dansu ahjussi. I had to enter, no matter what.

"Where is it?"

As if waiting for the question, Mitra pointed. As I looked where his finger indicated, a vast compression occurred at the vanishing point. This was likely Mitra’s vision. At the end of that compressed field, the bush was there.

「The Missing Bush.」

The moment I confirmed it, I understood Mitra’s warning. The immense narrative energy emanating from the thicket was so intense it made me shudder.

「An outer god.」

The deity within that bush was clearly one I shouldn't dare confront.

And yet, a chuckle escaped me anyway.

"It doesn't matter. I'm going in."

Mitra narrowed his eyes, questioning my sanity.

As he had said, what lay within that bush was, by this worldline's standards, an unmistakable 'outer deity'.

The reason I didn't hesitate was simple.

The 'outer deities' within that bush were people I knew very well.

「<Kim Dokja Company> is inside.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 982 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (3)

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[Again, I must disagree.]

Mitra’s skepticism was palpable. He looked at me as though I were a naive child, then heaved a deep sigh.

[I know you are familiar with the concept of 'Fear'. But the Outer Gods residing within that thicket are fundamentally different from the Fears you have encountered.]

I couldn't exactly tell him I knew those gods personally, so I offered a bitter smile instead. Mitra, perhaps misinterpreting my silence as stubbornness, adopted a grave tone.

[Even if you have ascended to the realm of myth, do not underestimate the 'gods of the other world'. The entities inside that bush are monsters I cannot guarantee a victory against.]

Of course he would say that.

"I know."

[And yet you insist on going?]

"Yes."

Mitra wasn't wrong; the beings inside would be dangerous. Above all, I had no way of knowing which version of <Kim Dokja Company> existed within that chaotic space.

"I have to go."

However, I had encountered members of <Kim Dokja Company> across worldlines before. Shin Yoosung, Lee Gilyoung—I had even seen other members during my brief time possessing the kkoma Kim Dokja.

Whoever was inside, I was certain of one thing.

「They would never harm me.」

The name itself was <Kim Dokja Company>. Those who had banded together under that banner and endured the hell of the scenarios would never raise a hand against Kim Dokja or his fragments.

[You... truly cherish your comrades.]

Had he doubted my resolve until now? Mitra looked genuinely impressed.

[The 'Sanctuary' will appear soon!]

A system message flashed above my head. The sky tore open with the roar of a thousand constellations, and a pillar of blinding light struck the earth. It was a spectacle reminiscent of Thor’s descent. A shimmering curtain of light formed around the impact point.

[A 'Sanctuary' has been generated!]

A five-minute timer materialized above the translucent barrier.

[Timer initiated!]

[When the timer expires, all participants within the 'Sanctuary' will be transferred to the 'Main Battlefield'.]

A total of twenty constellations could survive within that circle of light. Anna Croft, observing the phenomenon, murmured softly.

"This scenario is rigged for the Giant Nebulae."

I agreed. In a battle for territory like this, only a massive organization could secure and defend a zone for twenty members. The nebula that claimed the 'curtain of light' first would likely win the 'Battle of the Sanctuary'.

Amidst the rising tension, sparks crackled in the air, and a familiar figure materialized. It was a High-grade Dokkaebi I knew well.

[Finally! The 'Sanctuary' has arrived!]

It was Biryu—the dokkaebi who had overseen the Chungmuro scenario in the 1,864th round. He had been dispatched to manage this super-large battlefield.

[But... isn't this a bit unfair if we leave it like this?]

Several constellations muttered in confusion at his ominous tone.

[What do you mean?]

[Don't try anything stupid—]

Biryu snapped his fingers with a mischievous grin. Instantly, the massive curtain of light began to fracture.

[D-don't threaten me! T-This way, the big bullies get all the advantages. If we spread it out a bit... hehehehehe!]

The Sanctuary, designed for group defense, shattered into smaller fragments. It was a scene I knew all too well.

「Green Zones.」

Just like the dozens of Green Zones that had appeared in Chungmuro Station, the effective area of the Sanctuary split into scattered pockets.

[The 'effective area' of the Sanctuary is fragmenting!]

Like the Green Zones, the sizes varied wildly. Some were barely large enough for a single person, while others could fit two or three.

[Some constellations are greatly flustered by the altered scenario!]

[A few constellations are satisfied with the altered scenario!]

In a sense, Biryu's twisted 'fairness' was effective. It made it nearly impossible for a single, massive nebula to monopolize the safe zones. With the territory divided, smaller alliances and individual stars now had a fighting chance. A fierce, chaotic battle for those seats of light was about to erupt.

[Until we meet again, disciple of Jungyeong.]

The first to move was Hou Yi, the Sun Hunter. He claimed a single-person zone, aiming his massive bow at anyone who dared approach.

[The Sun Hunter accepts the challenge of the stars.]

A quiet, deadly aura radiated from him. Seeing the White Arrow nocked on his bow, no constellation dared to rush him. Challenging him now was tantamount to declaring war on the Emperor himself. Several other constellations—likely remnants of the <Emperor> nebula—took up positions in nearby zones, forming a defensive perimeter.

Mitra spoke next.

[Everyone, prepare for the scenario.]

It seemed Mitra intended to use this event to send his subordinates to safety.

[Chairman—]

[I will proceed to the 'Missing Bush'.]

At his declaration, the constellations of the Golden Dice Hall, including Skuld, looked torn.

[Chairman, no! That is too dangerous!]

Anticipating their protest, Mitra offered a benevolent smile.

[We will meet again soon. Survive. Even without me, you are strong enough if you stand together. The protection of the Golden Dice Hall remains with you.]

With that, Mitra ripped off one of his own arms and slammed it into the ground. A brilliant light erupted from the limb, bathing the constellations of the Golden Dice Hall in a protective aura.

[Ohhh...!]

A Myth-grade constellation had sacrificed a part of his own body to create a totem. Under its influence, his subordinates could fight with a fraction of his authority. Mitra turned his massive body toward me.

[Then let us make haste.]

I hadn't expected him to actually keep his word.

"Is it truly alright for you to accompany me?"

Mitra nodded.

[Your courage shames me. As a senior of the Mythical rank, I wish to fulfill my duty.]

It was unexpected, but I had no reason to refuse.

"Then let's go immediately."

War was breaking out over the sanctuaries. It was best to leave before the chaos escalated. I signaled to Jung Heewon and Anna Croft. Just in case, I had Anna carry the unconscious Kim Namwoon, leaving Jung Heewon free to fight if necessary.

"Anna Croft-ssi, take this."

I handed her the tickets I had stashed in my waistband.

"This is..."

"Tickets to the 'Main Battlefield'. Take the one for your friend on your back, too."

These were the tickets I had received from the 'Seeker of the End' before entering Valhalla.

"These are Blacklist Tickets, aren't they?"

"We might need them if things go south."

I couldn't guarantee their safety anymore. If the situation deteriorated, sending Anna and Namwoon to the higher scenario was the safer bet.

Anna examined the tickets closely.

"If I use a Blacklist Ticket, I will enter as part of the Calamity forces."

That was correct. She would be deployed on the side opposing the constellations of Ragnarok.

I smiled.

"Isn't that what you want?"

"..."

"Your goal is revenge against Asgard, isn't it?"

Her shoulders trembled slightly. She bit her lip, hesitating, before looking me in the eye.

"And you?"

"Me?"

"Which side are you on?"

"Why? Planning to follow me?"

Anna didn't answer. Grateful for her silence, I added:

"You know you have to side with Calamity regardless. That must be the term of your contract with the being who granted you the 'Eye of the Great Demon'."

Her eyes flickered with surprise.

"You knew about that?"

I nodded. The entity who gave her that eye was a key player in this Ragnarok. With their help, Anna Croft would be reborn as a central figure for the Calamity side.

"I will repay this debt. Definitely."

"I look forward to it."

A roar erupted behind us, followed by the clash of steel and magic. The Battle for the Sanctuary had begun.

[I will increase our speed.]

Mitra accelerated with a mantra. He could have moved this fast all along but had deliberately kept the pace slow.

Minutes passed. Finally, a dark, dense thicket appeared on the horizon.

[There it is.]

I sensed several constellations trailing us, but none dared to approach, wary of Mitra's presence.

[You have located the 'Missing Bush'!]

The thicket was right in front of us.

「Inside, I will find Dansu ahjussi.」

I took a step toward the bush, catching my breath. But the moment I stood before the threshold, the atmosphere shifted. A heavy, suffocating silence descended.

"Mitra."

I turned around. Mitra was watching me. Behind him, Jung Heewon and Anna Croft were trapped in a translucent pillar of light. Mitra's authority, [Prison of Light], had been activated.

[You knew, didn't you?]

Perhaps he had been stalling for time just to prepare this trap.

[That I am a coward.]

I gazed up at him quietly, thinking about the nature of a Myth-grade constellation—a star that has read a single story for tens of thousands of years, endlessly executing its own scenario.

"Didn't you say you wanted to escape the 'Hell of ■■'?"

Becoming a myth in the <Star Stream> might mean becoming the <Star Stream> itself. A being so accustomed to the system that it could no longer exist outside of it.

[That is correct.]

Mitra looked at me with eyes full of sorrow.

[I envy you. I envy the courage to throw it all away and disappear, despite having accumulated such a magnificent story.]

As I suspected, Mitra never intended to help me escape. His motive was simple: use my companions as leverage at the last moment to force a deal.

"What do you want?"

[When you roll the 'dice' at the Round Table... call my name. Just once.]

Mitra spoke with a strange, desperate madness.

[Do that, and I will give you anything.]

What he wanted wasn't escape. He was a star who yearned for ■■ more desperately than anyone else. A being who would sacrifice everything just to witness the final scene.

[Promise me. Call my True Name there. If you do, I will grant you my 'Power of Resurrection'! If you seek the aid of <Vedas>, I will grant that too! So—]

"That desire..."

I looked him in the eye.

"Is it truly your will? Or is it the will of the stories that turned you into a 'myth'?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 983 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (4)

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[Is that... important?]

The moment Mitra asked, sparks erupted in the air again. Then, the voice of Dokkaebi Biryu cut through the tension.

[Didn't I tell you before? If you don't enter the sanctuary— well, you'll meet a terrible fate!]

Startled, Mitra raised his head just as a deafening roar echoed across the battlefield.

[A 'Disaster' descends upon the 'Super-Large Battlefield'!]

With a sound like the earth tearing apart, the terrain began to twist and buckle.

[The 'World Serpent' has appeared on the 'Super-Large Battlefield'!]

A majestic, crushing pressure descended upon us. I observed the calamity with calm eyes.

「It was an expected development.」

With a mythical constellation like Mitra active, the balance of the scenario demanded a counterforce. Just as the 'Apocalypse Dragon' had appeared in the 'Battlefield of Myths',

it was only natural that a similar disaster would strike here.

[Impossible.]

Mitra glared at me, eyes wide with betrayal. He was right to be angry. The reason I had brought him along—despite his obvious agenda—was because I needed a shield to temporarily block this very disaster.

「The 'World Serpent' is one of the key calamities associated with 'Ragnarok'.」

Of course, there was no way the real World Serpent would appear here. The true 'Jormungandr' of Ragnarok was a Myth-grade catastrophe on a cosmic scale.

So, the 'World Serpent' summoned here...

[The Black Serpent of the East—]

As Mitra muttered the name, the summoned giant snake turned its nine heads toward me.

"I never thought I'd encounter that constellation here."

'Yamata no Orochi'. The constellation that had plagued Peaceland—the 'Eight-Headed Sovereign'. It had been twisted into a 'Disaster' and unleashed upon us.

[The constellation, 'Eight-Headed Sovereign', roars!]

Yamata no Orochi shook its massive heads and unleashed a breath of venomous energy. The constellations caught in the blast screamed as their incarnations disintegrated.

Ooooooh!

Orochi thrust five of its heads through the melting terrain. Mitra, undeterred, unleashed his power.

[How dare you!]

A spear of light materialized in the air, blasting two of Orochi's heads into oblivion. However, three other heads successfully clamped onto Mitra's limbs, tearing through his defense. At the same time, his [Prison of Light] shattered.

"Dokja-ssi!"

Mitra shouted, spotting Jung Heewon and Anna Croft, who had escaped the broken prison.

[No! Could it be...? The Round Table!]

This was our last chance. Without hesitation, I grabbed my companions and opened the 'Missing Bush'. A pitch-black swirl of darkness began to suck us in.

[Stop!]

Mitra was persistent. As if determined to destroy us if he couldn't have us, he risked being devoured by Orochi to hurl his spear of light at our retreating forms.

I went cold as I watched the terrifying spears slash through the air. I deflected a few with 'Unbreakable Faith', but blocking them all was impossible.

The moment I prepared to shield them with my own body—

[Step back, you wicked foreign power!]

Someone stepped in front of us, taking Mitra's spear. He swung a long bamboo stick, deflecting the incoming light with a desperate strength.

I recognized him immediately.

[The constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', protects you!]

The Great Master Samyeong, who had lost his incarnation in 'Valhalla Hall', had joined this large-scale battlefield to the end.

The holy relic of the Great Master, having absorbed the impact of a Myth-grade attack, lost its glow and began to crumble. With a crackling sound, his incarnation body, impaled by the spear, began to spill its story.

[Go.]

If we left now, Great Master Samyeong would die. I reached out, but he shook his head and pushed me away. His body was tattered, his existence fading. Yet, the star of the Korean Peninsula shone brightly in his final moments. He looked past me, fixing his gaze on Anna Croft.

[Thank you... my descendant.]

The swirling darkness engulfed us. Mitra's sorrowful roar echoed in the distance, quickly drowned out by a bitter, biting cold. If I hadn't been gripping Jung Heewon and Anna Croft's wrists, the cold would have severed my sense of their existence entirely.

In a world where time seemed frozen, a sound echoed—like gears clicking into place.

Click.

Something fell out of alignment. Something broke. And then, the sound of something being forcibly realigned.

A record appeared before my eyes.

「This 'world beyond' is a place where the laws we know do not apply.」

Jung Heewon and Anna Croft looked at me with startled eyes.

"Dokja-ssi."

"Something is wrong."

A faint light enveloped us. Then, Anna Croft and the unconscious Kim Namwoon were wrapped in a sudden, violent storm of probability.

「Why?」

Alarm bells rang in my head. Why was the storm hitting only those two?

I didn't understand the cause, but the subsequent record revealed the consequence.

「The 'world' we are moving into does not accept 'Anna Croft' or 'Kim Namwoon'.」

Terrified by the implication, I shouted at Anna.

"Tear the tickets! Quickly!"

Sparks exploded from her body the moment I screamed. Fortunately, she must have torn both tickets in time, as I saw her vanish along with Kim Namwoon.

Startled, Jung Heewon cried out.

"Dokja—"

"Hold on tight!"

The surrounding space-time shuddered violently, as if the foreign objects had been safely expelled.

「And the story begins.」

Jung Heewon and I felt our bodies melting. Without a moment to resist, we became part of the stream of space-time. My vision flickered, and the history of the universe unfolded before my eyes. Countless stars spread out where the first light had once been. Galaxies formed, illuminated by the stories that birthed them.

「The Star Stream.」

The world of stories I'd read, written, and lived through. As if I were a fluid, I flowed through all those galaxies, heading toward the end of a long history.

「There was a great wall there.」

As I looked at the wall, the wall looked back at me. I felt the great records within it respond—fiercely calling out, begging me to choose.

I chose one.

「A certain ending.」

I chose it because the emotions of the people I longed to meet were so strong within that record.

The moment I touched it, I felt my body regenerating. Dizziness washed over me as the surroundings brightened, the abstract record transforming into a tangible landscape.

「There, a blindingly white hospital room unfolded before me.」

My heart pounded.

「Inside that room stood the people he had longed for so much.」

I tried to call their names. But my voice remained silent. It was only natural. My voice was not permitted in this 'hospital room'.

「They are beings we can only meet outside of this narrative.」

I am a reader. A being who observes.

「There was <Kim Dokja Company>.」

Han Sooyoung, Yoo Joonghyuk, Yoo Sangah, Shin Yoosung, Lee Gilyoung, Jung Heewon, Lee Hyunsung, Lee Seolhwa, Lee Jihye, Jang Hayoung...

The <Kim Dokja Company> I knew.

They were in that hospital room.

「"I'm going to the first portal!"」

It was a scene I knew very well.

「"Isn't anyone thinking something strange? If you go to the first one, you'll be able to meet Dokja-ssi again. Right, Biyoo?"」

Jung Heewon's voice. Not the Jung Heewon I knew—but the Jung Heewon of the 1,864th round, the one who remembered Kim Dokja.

「Two portals stood before my eyes.」

The moment I saw them, I realized what I was witnessing.

「"What are you all hesitating for? Aren't you going in? We can meet Dokja-ssi again. The Dokja-ssi we remember is out there."」

I knew this scene. The 'two portals' left behind by the Oldest Dream.

「This scene is the unknown ending of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.」

<Kim Dokja Company>, having reached its conclusion, faced two choices.

The first portal: 'The ending where Kim Dokja returns'.

The second portal: 'The ending where Kim Dokja does not return'.

Jung Heewon was arguing for the first. She believed that if they went there, they could be reunited.

「"I'm not going."」

But someone opposed her.

「"The first portal is clearly a trap. It's so obvious. Have you already forgotten what happened on the subway?"」

It was Han Sooyoung.

「"It was like this back then. You were tricked by Kim Dokja and brought out a fake."」

Amidst the group's hesitation, Han Sooyoung explained why they had to choose the 'second portal'.

「"What if we enter the first portal only to find a Kim Dokja who lacks the same quality as before?"」

They longed to meet the 'Kim Dokja' they remembered.

「"And I will track down each and every one of the 'Kim Dokja fragments' who imagined that ending and torment them until they come up with a proper 'ending'."」

She spoke of the people who wanted to love even the 'misfortune' imagined by the Kim Dokja who had become their 'Oldest Dream'.

「"I'll catch that guy and bring him back, no matter what. I'm tired of playing with numbers, whether it's 49% or 51%. He has to be 100% now."」

So they chose the second portal. They set out to find the scattered fragments of their reader.

「That was the beginning of this whole story.」

I watched the backs of <Kim Dokja Company> as they entered the portal. Han Sooyoung, Yoo Joonghyuk, and Biyoo disappeared. Lee Gilyoung and Lee Jihye followed.

Shin Yoosung looked back one last time just before vanishing. Without realizing it, I reached out to the child. I wanted to tell her not to go. But I couldn't. In this story, I wasn't the author.

As the group made their choices and disappeared, the hospital room door creaked open once again.

「They are the stars who have long loved this story.」

The constellations I knew were there. With <Kim Dokja Company> gone, they, too, had come to choose their own ending.

「Just as the lights on the stage go out, the stars choose their own finale.」

The characters departed. Soon, only the two portals remained in the empty hospital room. I sat down and stared blankly at the void they had left behind. Why did they have to make that choice? Even if it was all a lie, couldn't they have imagined a happy ending with their eyes closed?

「This story begins with such a question.」

Slowly, I raised my head. A sentence began to appear before my eyes.

「What would this story have been like if the group had chosen the 'first portal'?」

I rose from my seat and, as if entranced, walked toward the first portal, which was still glowing brightly.

「What kind of world lies beyond that portal that Han Sooyoung and her group refused to choose?」

As if waiting, the swirling portal sucked me in.

And so, the story began.

「This is the story of that 'house'.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 984 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (5)

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【Oh, it's finally starting.】

【Who's going to record this?】

【Haha, I was so exhausted earlier, it's embarrassing.】

...

【Who needs to step forward? He's the 'Recorder', after all.】

---

「All happy families are alike, but every unhappy family is unhappy in its own way.」

This is the opening line of Tolstoy's novel, [Anna Karenina]. The reason I'm suddenly recalling that line is because I suddenly wondered what a 'happy family' truly is.

Are all happy families really the same? If so, do the conditions for happiness apply equally to most people?

「I wish I lived in a really big house.」

For some, that means living in a really big house.

「I wish I could eat as much pizza and chicken as I want.」

Eating as much pizza and chicken as they want.

「I should be able to play computer games, too.」

「There should be a hospital nearby. I think Dokja-ssi gets sick often.」

「He'd be happy to have a library.」

Perhaps that scene was no different from that of any other 'happy family'. To someone who didn't know their story, that scene of happiness would surely seem ordinary.

「What do you think happiness is, Ahjussi?」

When someone asked, I thought for a moment and then answered. The most ordinary scene of happiness I could think of.

「Not being alone.」

And when I opened my eyes.

"Youngest, are you awake?"

I was no longer a reader.

rlaehrwk37: Wow?

His name was Kim Dokja.

He didn't know who gave him that name. It could have been the work of his parents, whose lives are unknown. Perhaps one of them was a great book lover.

He didn't care either way. People just called him Kim Dokja, and he accepted that name. He thought that was enough. Perhaps it was because of his unfamiliar name, but sometimes, when people heard him for the first time, they'd laugh and say,

"You seem to really like books!"

At those times, he'd just give a wry smile. It was because he didn't really enjoy reading. To be precise, it wasn't so much that he didn't like it, but rather that he was forced to.

"Books? Why would you read something like that?"

Perhaps it was largely due to the influence of his siblings, all of whom were physical.

"Aren't you going to wake up quickly? Did you fall asleep while looking at your phone again?"

The door opened with a loud crack. His signature platinum hair flowed in a dazzling stream. The eldest son, half-naked, showed off his toned chest. Wukong grabbed Kim Dokja by the collar and dragged him out of bed. Kim Dokja rubbed his sleepy eyes and grumbled.

"Hyung, can't I sleep a little longer?"

"It's time for your morning stretch. You promised."

As he dragged himself outside, as if dragged by Wukong, the second, already in the middle of a workout in the living room, greeted him.

"Are you awake?"

As expected, the muscles are as hot as the first one. With a friendly face that doesn't suit such muscles, the second— Hyunsung was doing a crunch.

"Okay, let's get started. Remember what I told you?"

Kim Dokja sat on a small yoga mat and assumed the poses Wukong had instructed. He crouched and stretched like a cat, and then lay down and repeated simple hamstring stretches. It was a tedious exercise, but after repeating it over and over again, sweat beaded on his forehead.

It's hard. He thought about quitting.

But watching Wukong and Hyunsung silently immerse themselves in their workouts, he couldn't say such things.

That's the level of stamina I needed to achieve such a muscular body.

"Good job. Bend down even further. That's right."

With all this support from Wukong, even his frail body seemed poised to become muscular in no time.

"Like this?"

"That's right!"

Of course, he knew that stretching a hundred times a day wouldn't make him muscular. He's old enough to understand that now.

After finishing his full-body stretches and standing up, the two brothers were staring at him.

"Aren't you going to eat?"

Normally, it would have been time to go eat breakfast after stretching, but today, their expressions were unusually serious.

"Isn't it about time you taught him 'that'?"

That.

Wukong beamed at Hyunsung's words and asked.

"You think so too?"

Kim Dokja's heart suddenly pounded. For some reason, this morning felt different than usual.

"Why, what's that?"

The two exchanged glances, ignoring Kim Dokja's question.

"But I think it's a bit much for the Youngest."

"He can't stay ignorant forever, right?"

"I see."

Their expressions seemed as if they were about to impart some great martial arts secret.

Kim Dokja tensed up once again.

Would he finally hear 'that'?

There were things that had always seemed strange.

Why was his name Kim Dokja? Why didn't he remember his parents? How did his siblings end up living together?

"Oh, what is it?"

Hiding his excitement, Kim Dokja asked cautiously. Then, after much deliberation, Wukong said,

"Okay. I'll tell you. Hyunsung-ah, demonstrate."

"Yes."

Hyunsung fell to the floor as if he had been waiting. Wukong then began counting.

"One. Two. Three. Four."

Hyunsung's body swayed up and down with the steadily increasing numbers. Kim Dokja asked with a dumbfounded expression,

"What is that?"

"Ah, this is called a push-up."

"I know that. Why are you showing me?"

"It might look easy on the outside, but it's not an easy exercise at all."

Embarrassed at having been thrilled by a mere push-up, Kim Dokja knelt down beside Hyunsung and began to do push-ups.

"I can do that without you teaching me."

"Huh?"

Kim Dokja's arms slowly lowered to the floor. His already weak muscles sounded like they were being ripped apart.

"That's right! Now, just come back up!"

He managed to lower his chest, trembling, but that was where the problem started. His upper body showed no sign of lifting.

Damn it. He can't even do one?

"Youngest, you can do it. Come up!"

Amidst the enthusiastic cheering, Kim Dokja pushed off the floor with all his might.

Hyunsung shouted,

"Think of pushing as if you were pushing a mountain!"

Little by little, the ground began to give way. And finally—

"One."

Wukong's voice came softly. A wave of weakness washed over Kim Dokja, and he collapsed.

"You've grown, Youngest."

Wukong smiled contently. Then Hyunsung added, tears welling up in his eyes.

"Really, you're amazing. As expected, Dokja-ssi—"

"What's the fuss about doing a single push-up?"

Kim Dokja pouted, and Wukong chuckled and rubbed his shoulder.

"Did you say our Youngest is on leave from work starting today?"

"I said retirement."

"Isn't that the same thing?"

Wukong, incidentally, was the most stubborn of his siblings.

"A leave of absence is a short break, and retirement is permanent."

"You're going to find another job after a short break anyway, right? Then it's the same as a leave of absence."

He'd never thought of it that way.

Kim Dokja shook his head and muttered.

"Anyway, I'm going to take a break for a while."

Actually, it wasn't the right time to take a break from work. This family couldn't live a normal life without him.

"Are you serious?"

The Eldest, a longtime unemployed man, asked.

"Are you sure?"

The Second, who had recently been fired for being hard-working but too inflexible, asked.

"Yes, I'm really going to take a break."

If the Youngest didn't bring in the money, this family wouldn't function properly. Nevertheless, upon hearing Kim Dokja's words, the Eldest, Wukong, and the Second, Hyunsung, looked genuinely touched.

"Good idea, Youngest."

"Good idea."

Why were these two so happy at the mere mention of taking a break?

"You know if I take a break, our household won't have any money, right?"

"So what if we don't earn enough? We can just be frugal. We can eat out less and not buy unnecessary things. Isn't that how we should live?"

"Even an unemployed person saying something like that isn't very convincing."

"Money is something that disappears even after it's been there."

"Have you ever had it?"

"You don't know, but I used to have a lot of money."

"When?"

Frowning in frustration, Wukong was about to say something when the third's voice came from afar.

"You guys, stop wasting calories and come eat breakfast."

The family's breakfast began.

---

The breakfast menu was kimchi fried rice and a fried egg made with cold rice.

Was it the Third's turn to cook today?

Kim Dokja sat across from her, quietly watching the Third scooping up rice with a spoon. Their eyes met, and the Third— Heewon, smiled and asked.

"It's delicious, isn't it?"

It might sound strange, but she was more skilled at using knives than cooking. Heewon's cooking was surprisingly neatly prepared, but also surprisingly poorly seasoned.

"Yeah, it's delicious."

"It's not?"

It was a lie. Some parts were overly salty, others were overly plain. Still, he was grateful that someone had prepared the food for him, that he could eat it.

Of course, that was just Kim Dokja's opinion, and the other brothers felt a little differently.

"It's so tasteless."

"Say it again."

"I find it delicious, Heewon-ssi."

After a lively meal, the siblings cleared away the dishes.

Hyunsung was in charge of the dishes today.

"Deep in the mountains—"

Hyunsung continued to wash the dishes, singing a military song in a slightly off-key tone. Kim Dokja watched Hyunsung's back, inhaling the lingering scent of dishwashing

detergent wafting through the house. It was a familiar sight, but for some reason, his heart tingled.

It was then that the Eldest emerged from the closet, dressed in a neat suit. Their eyes met, and Wukong asked with a triumphant smile.

"How is it?"

"What?"

"From today, I'm off to work."

"Off to work?"

He asked, startled, and the other said he was going for an interview today. It was the security firm that Hyunsung had previously been laid off from.

"Really? My brother's interviewing?"

"Yes, you rascal."

It turns out there are days when Kim Wukong goes for an interview.

Kim Dokja was amazed, but upon closer inspection, Wukong's tie was a mess.

"How can you possibly get a job if you can't even tie a tie yourself?"

"Hmm? Isn't this how it's supposed to be done?"

Kim Dokja sighed and showed him how to tie a tie. He'd only adjusted one part of it, but he still looked quite neat.

"Oh, you're the Youngest, after all."

"Memorize it well. It's much more useful than push-ups."

"Okay. I'll be back."

"Go ahead. Don't cause trouble."

"On your phone."

"You shouldn't read novels. They pollute your mind."

"Let's take the child lock off and talk. What's wrong with novels?"

"They're all fake. You should live in real life. Instead of reading those things, do one more push-up. Like Hyunsung."

Hyunsung, who was beside him, nodded.

Seeing that Hyunsung was already dressed for the day, it seemed he was taking Wukong with him today.

"Have a safe trip. Good luck with your interview. Don't hit anyone."

The two waved and disappeared, leaving Kim Dokja and the Third child, Heewon, in the house. Heewon said, "Youngest."

"Yeah."

"You know it's Hyunsung-ssi's birthday soon, right?"

By the way, Heewon calls Hyunsung 'Hyunsung-ssi'. Even Kim Dokja doesn't know why.

"When was the Second's birthday?"

"June 20th."

"There's still a long way to go."

"Still, it's better to think about it in advance."

Hyunsung's birthday present. What kind of gift would he like? Would he like a new push-up bar? Or maybe a pair of adjustable dumbbells?

"But, sis."

"Yeah."

"When was my birthday?"

"It's February 15th."

"How old is the second oldest brother?"

"Twenty-eight."

Kim Dokja pondered for a moment and then asked.

"How old am I this year?"

"Twenty..."

Heewon, who had just finished speaking, suddenly widened her eyes and asked.

"Don't you even know your age?"

"No, I know. I'm just asking because it's strange."

"What's strange?"

"I'm twenty-eight this year, too."

"But?"

"The second oldest brother is twenty-eight, too?"

"So?"

"I was born on February 15th. My birthday is earlier, so why—"

He felt something hit him hard in the back of his head, and his vision blurred. What was it? When he opened his eyes again, Heewon was supporting him.

"Are you okay? You suddenly collapsed."

"Yeah, I'm fine."

Seeing Heewon's impudent expression, Kim Dokja narrowed his eyes and asked.

"But how old was sister?"

"Twenty-seven."

"But why are you—"

The back of his head tingled again, and his vision spun around. He blinked, and this time, Heewon was supporting him again.

"Are you okay?"

Was he okay?

Watching Heewon's palm slowly rise again, Kim Dokja made a request instead of a question.

"Teach me how to do push-ups."

"Why do you do push-ups?"

"I just want to get better."

"There's no use getting stronger. There's no need to get stronger."

"Still, I want to get better."

After a moment of hesitation, Heewon answered.

"Okay."

The two quietly began doing push-ups. To be precise, Heewon did them, and Kim Dokja watched.

"You're good at it."

"It's just push-ups, what's the big deal?"

"I'm not even good at that."

Heewon was silent for a moment, then said,

"You're good at other things."

"What am I good at?"

Heewon didn't answer. She simply looked at him with slightly sad eyes and silently gazed out the window.

Kim Dokja also looked out the window with Heewon. The small living room of the 3LDK. Through the large windows of the living room, the cityscape was reflected. People bustling along the busy road. Children talking from somewhere. The sound of a ball bouncing. The occasional car exhaust.

It was peaceful. Truly, a world where nothing happened.

Just then, as if a memory suddenly occurred to her, Heewon said,

"Oh, I'm going to work later."

"Work? Where?"

"I decided to go back to that cafe. I think I should go soon."

"What? Did you make up with the boss?"

"Just got a pay cut."

"You said you didn't want to work there."

"You can't make a living doing only what you love."

"Still—"

"You've always been the only one working. We can do it too."

It felt strange to suddenly hear that. Heewon seemed to be quite concerned that he was earning his own living.

"I'm fine. I'll take a short break and then look for another job. My brother told me there's no retirement, only a leave of absence."

"No, while you're at it, get some rest. I can't just be dependent on you here too."

"Here too?"

Heewon paused, then smiled subtly and waved.

"I'll be back soon, so take care of the house. Don't go anywhere. If you want anything to eat, text me. I'll make it for you later."

After seeing Heewon off, Kim Dokja gazed out the window alone. He saw Heewon walking somewhere in the distance.

Kim Dokja waved lightly to Heewon, who didn't turn around. Watching her back, he felt as if he had seen a similar scene before.

People were leaving one by one, leaving him alone in an empty space.

Displeased with this feeling, Kim Dokja thought about Wukong, who had gone to an interview, Hyunsung, who was about to celebrate his birthday, and Heewon, who was going to work at the cafe.

First, Wukong would probably fail in his job search. No company would accept his irascibility and laziness.

Second, Hyunsung would completely forget his birthday. Only on the day itself would he finally remember it. Then, realizing no one had congratulated him, he would be depressed, and then, realizing it was all a surprise, he would receive congratulations and tears would well up in his eyes. Third, Heewon would fight with the boss again. And at night, she would come home drunk and tell the story of the day. Kim Dokja loved those little incidents.

He loved the stories of the people he loved. He was happy that he was in those stories, that he had siblings. He loved this strange family.

So, whenever he was alone, he would wish this time could last forever. He wished this seemingly unbelievable peace, this daily routine of practicing push-ups, could last forever.

Ding-dong.

That's when the doorbell rang. He looked outside through the intercom, but the screen was broken.

"Anyway, this house can't function properly without me."

He hesitated for a moment, then stood before the front door and quietly muttered, "Who is it?" There was no answer. Slowly reaching for the handle, Wukong's advice suddenly came to mind.

—No matter what, never open the door when you're alone.

Wukong spoke as if teaching a child the fears of the world.

—You may not remember clearly, but you're suffering from amnesia. Something terrible happened when you were young.

In fact, Kim Dokja barely remembered anything from his childhood.

—There's a stalker following you. He only wears black clothes. He's dangerous, so you have to be careful.

When he first heard the story, Kim Dokja thought it was just a ghost story. A stalker wearing black clothes.

Ding-dong.

The doorbell rang again.

Kim Dokja hesitated for a moment, then reached for the handle again. Maybe, just like Wukong said, there really was a stalker at the door.

So what should he do? Should he call his brothers? Or should he report it to the police?

Even as he pondered these thoughts, Kim Dokja couldn't stop reaching out.

Perhaps it was an impulsive choice.

The thought that there could never be a stalker, and the thought that if there really was one, he'd just like to see their face.

With these conflicting feelings, Kim Dokja opened the door.

「What if, when I open the door, there's a world he doesn't know about out there?」

But when I carefully opened the door, there was no one at the front door. Not even the hem of the man's clothes could be seen, let alone the man in black.

Kim Dokja smiled bitterly.

Of course.

But the moment he was about to close the door, there was a sound of something being dragged outside. He opened it again and poked his head out, and there was a small box sitting there.

What is this? A package?

He absentmindedly picked up the box and entered the house. There was no tracking number on it.

—Oh, and never open a package alone.

His heart suddenly raced. A package with no tracking number.

「Finally, something has happened in his world.」

—Leave it to your older brother or sister. It's dangerous if you open it alone.

He wondered if there might be something truly dangerous inside, but then he realized that it couldn't be.

"Who do you think as a fool?"

So what if there was something dangerous inside? Although he could only do one push-up, he was a fully grown man of twenty-eight years. There was no way someone would have put something like a bomb in the box, and he didn't think anything bad could happen if he opened it alone.

Kim Dokja slowly opened the box.

「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.」

Instead of a bomb, there was a book.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 985 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (6)

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Wukong silently gazed up at the sky, then abruptly spat out a curse.

"Fuck."

In the world he originally inhabited, such language would have been filtered out. It was all because of that damned Archangel. Due to her strict system of 'correct and beautiful speech', all constellations influenced by <Kim Dokja Company> were subject to forced censorship.

But now, that was all history. The Archangel had chosen a different 'portal' and departed for another world.

「"Great Sage Heaven's Equal. Are you truly going there?"」

The Archangel had asked Wukong, the only constellation who made a different choice.

「"Yes."」

When he answered, she pressed him: 'You know Kim Dokja well. The Kim Dokja we know will not exist in the worldline you have chosen. If he insisted on offering two choices, there must be a reason.'

「"Of course."」

Wukong knew that. He had been watching Kim Dokja's story longer than almost anyone.

「"And yet, you choose that world?"」

The Archangel was right. The world he chose might not hold the 'Youngest' he remembered. Nevertheless, Wukong chose this 'ending'. The reason was simple.

「"At least one star should remain to illuminate the little theme park he created."」

Upon hearing his answer, the Archangel gazed at him with sorrowful eyes before slowly nodding.

「"Let us meet again."」

Both stars knew they likely never would. They would never again giggle over the same story. They would never share their rage or their joy. They would never compete for sponsorship or send indirect messages bickering with one another.

「"Yes."」

They prayed for each other's stories, hoping they would reach the endings they desired in the worlds they chose.

「I wonder how she is doing.」

Today, Wukong found himself curious about the ending the Archangel had chosen. What was happening there right now? Once, out of sheer curiosity, he had tried to peek into that world. A problem arose immediately, so he stopped, but...

"Welcome."

As he pushed open the convenience store door, the clerk's mechanical greeting rang out.

Wukong nodded slightly and headed to the beverage section. He picked up a bottle of soju, considered it, then put it back. Alcohol from the human world couldn't even get him tipsy. Wukong hated <Emperor>, but he missed the celestial wine he used to steal from the heavens. Especially on days like today, when he desperately wanted to get drunk.

"Even so... if you have absolutely no experience..."

The interviewer at the security firm pushed his glasses up his nose, looking utterly perplexed.

"You need at least a minimum amount of relevant history to perform security duties."

Who dares lecture the Great Sage on 'security experience'? Wukong, feeling deeply offended, frowned and snapped.

"I have experience."

No bodyguard in the history of the universe had performed a more grueling escort mission.

"I protected a Buddhist monk all the way to India. Have you not heard of it?"

His 'Journey to the West' was one of the most famous stories in the Star Stream. Of course, the interviewer, who had no way of knowing this, looked at him as if he were insane and scribbled something on his notepad.

"What do you consider your greatest strength?"

Strength. What was his strength?

It was the first time he had been asked such a question in this context. Wukong pondered the stories of his life. After a long silence, he answered.

"I am confident in combat."

Fighting. If asked to name the strongest stars in the universe, he would easily make the top five. The only thing he might be wary of was that black bastard—the one wielding the power of the 'Oldest Liberator', an authority that transcended even myths.

"Fighting..."

The interviewer, unfamiliar with the concept of Myth-grade constellations, looked displeased.

"What do you think 'security' is?"

"It is protection."

"And how do you protect something?"

"Simple. You eliminate the threat."

The interviewer shook his head.

"No."

"What?"

"That is not protection."

"Then?"

"True security begins with acknowledging the impossible."

Wukong was momentarily taken aback by the philosophical weight of the answer.

"What do you mean? If you give up from the start, you cannot protect anything."

"It isn't giving up."

The interviewer continued, as if lecturing a student.

"There are accidents in this world that human power cannot prevent. If a building suddenly collapses, how will you protect your client?"

"I would simply destroy the collapsing debris."

"What if the vehicle you are in is rear-ended by a truck?"

"I would grab the client and jump out."

"What if a missile falls from the sky?"

"That..."

That was beyond the scope of a bodyguard. Just as he was thinking the interviewer was being unreasonable, the man smiled meaningfully.

"Interesting. How far are you willing to go to prevent the inevitable?"

"What?"

"You failed the interview. Go home and guard your house."

That was the end of it. He wondered what to tell Hyunsung, who had pulled strings to get him this interview. But since Hyunsung had already been fired from this same company, perhaps the problem wasn't them, but the company itself.

"Security."

He chuckled to himself. In truth, he was performing security every day. He was doing it right now.

"Youngest! Hyung is home!"

Wukong shouted as he entered the hallway and rang the doorbell.

But there was no answer. It was strange. The Youngest should have been home.

After pacing for a moment, Wukong grabbed the doorknob, then thought better of it and dialed a number.

"Heewon-ah."

—Why are you calling?

"What was the passcode for the door?"

A deep sigh came from the other end.

—What? You don't even remember the Youngest's birthday?

"Of course I know his birthday."

—Right. There's no way a freeloader like you would memorize something important.

He wanted to snap back, but her words were too accurate to refute.

—How did the interview go?

Beep. Beep. Wukong punched in the familiar date.

"I failed."

—I knew it.

"Listen to me. This time, it really could have worked out."

—You're ridiculous. I'm hanging up.

"No, really, listen. I think that interviewer was—"

The door clicked open. Wukong stopped speaking.

The air inside the house felt wrong. Subtly, terrifyingly wrong. He saw a delivery box sitting open in the entryway. There was no tracking number on it.

Ignoring Heewon's voice pecking at him through the phone, Wukong scanned the house.

No. It couldn't be. A single moment of carelessness couldn't lead to this.

"Heewon-ah."

He raised his senses, sniffing the air. There was no mistaking it. All his instincts pointed to a single, devastating truth.

"Come home. Right now."

The object of his guard had vanished.

An hour later, the three of them were gathered in the living room. In the suffocating silence, Heewon spoke first.

"Didn't he just go out for some fresh air?"

"If that were the case, would I have called you?"

"I mean, maybe he just went to the store. If we make a fuss and he walks in, I'm going to kill you, seriously."

"This doesn't feel right. Something has happened to the Youngest."

"I get it, you're protective. But he's twenty-eight. No, technically, he's even older than that..."

"Twenty-eight is practically a baby."

"That's just based on your perception of time—"

Hyunsung intervened, stepping between them.

"Both of you, calm down. First, look at this."

"What is it?"

"I installed it a while ago, just in case."

Hyunsung held up his smartphone. On the screen was a live feed of the living room. He had installed a hidden home cam above the television.

"What? When did you put that there?"

"When Dokja-ssi was absent the other day. I only put them in the living room and his bedroom."

If Kim Dokja had heard this, he would have launched a lecture about human rights and privacy. But none of the three cared about that right now. Their only interest was his safety.

"Rewind it. Quickly."

Hyunsung scrolled back the timeline.

Someone rang the doorbell. Kim Dokja hesitated, then opened the door. He stepped out, returned with a box, and took out a book.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

The three of them exchanged horrified glances as they confirmed the title on the screen.

"What on earth..."

Who had delivered that book? More importantly, how could that 'story' exist within this 'world'?

Wukong, staring intently at the screen, spoke grimly.

"Something similar happened before."

Once, the Youngest had downloaded an unknown app on his phone. Through that app, he had begun reading the novel. Fortunately, Hyunsung had discovered it and engaged the child lock, and Heewon had struck the back of his head to reset his memory.

"The Youngest must not read that story."

When Wukong spoke, the other two nodded in unison.

For reasons they didn't fully understand, the Kim Dokja of this world had sealed his memories deep within his subconscious. The three believed this was his will, and they

had decided to respect—and enforce—it. It was tragic that he couldn't remember them, but if he had chosen this ending, there must have been a reason.

"Where is he now? You installed a tracker, didn't you?"

"The GPS is off."

Hyunsung's voice cracked. Heewon slumped onto the sofa, clutching her forehead as dizziness washed over her.

"Are you alright?"

"I'm fine. Just... a headache. It's been lingering since yesterday."

Her words carried a strange weight. Sensing the shifting atmosphere, Wukong narrowed his eyes.

"Someone has interfered with this world."

Heewon closed her eyes, leaning her head back.

"Should we report it to the police?"

Wukong shook his head.

"We won't find him that way."

This world was a small theme park created by Kim Dokja's subconscious. A world constructed from his desire to live in a big house with his companions.

"You know this better than anyone. This reality operates on the Youngest's imagination."

Kim Dokja didn't know it, but he was the one sustaining this world. If he truly wanted to hide, they would never find him.

Hyunsung's face darkened.

"Then what do we do? If something happens to Dokja-ssi..."

"It's not hopeless. We have a clue."

Heewon opened her eyes. Hyunsung looked up from the screen.

Wukong continued.

"If the Youngest really read 'that story'..."

There was only one book in the box.

"There is only one place he would go."

At Wukong's words, Heewon stood up abruptly.

"Let's go."

The destination was clear.

「The place where this whole story began.」

And...

「The place where he first saw the Youngest.」

Kim Dokja would be there.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 986 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (7)

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「Oksu Station.」

Moments later, the trio stepped onto the platform at Oksu Station. Heewon blinked again, her eyes slowly scanning the familiar surroundings. A cool wind swept past them. The scenery of the Han River stretched out before them, carrying a faint, metallic scent of water. Pausing near Dongho Bridge, which led toward Apgujeong, the three allowed themselves a moment of reminiscence.

Heewon was the first to speak.

"Something feels... off."

Wukong pursed his lips and responded.

"It shouldn't be strange, considering this isn't 'that world'."

"But the location is exactly the same."

Heewon was well aware. This world was not the one they had lived in. Still, the moment she saw the open bridge, she remembered the day the scenarios began. She knew full well this wasn't her world, but she couldn't suppress the memories.

The three of them gazed at the bridge in silence for a long while. Here, no Dokkaebis appeared, the subway didn't stop, no monsters gave chase, and no dragons tore the bridge asunder. In the absence of such chaos, only their memories remained as proof that the story had existed.

Heewon bit her lip in silence. It had been a truly horrific time. Yet, she wondered why she looked back on this memory with such fondness.

A slight wave of dizziness made Heewon stumble once more, prompting Hyunsung to quickly grab her shoulder. Watching them, Wukong spoke up.

"Wait here for a bit while I take a look around."

"I'll come with you."

"It's easier if I go alone."

Wukong glanced at Heewon and Hyunsung before adding in a low voice.

"This probably won't be a very pleasant memory for you."

With those words, Wukong's figure quickly pulled away.

Watching him go, Heewon was reminded that he had once been a star in the sky. He was a constellation that had once enjoyed watching their tragedy. Wukong must have decided he didn't deserve to share the same memories as them.

"I wonder if he's being considerate or just aloof."

"That's right."

Wukong was clearly a constellation. A star that had witnessed their tragedy. But now, to them, Wukong was more than just a constellation.

Hyunsung hesitated for a moment, then spoke.

"I know this sounds strange, but... I'm often grateful that star watched our story to the end."

"…"

"I don't know if this is the right place to talk about this, but…"

"No, I know what you mean."

In that desperate scenario, if not for that single sliver of starlight before their eyes, they wouldn't have seen the end.

"It's infuriating that he enjoyed seeing me suffer, but that person sacrificed everything to protect us in the final chapter."

"…"

"It's not a matter of simply forgiving him; after all, we shared every moment."

They experienced that story together and survived to the end. So here they were now.

"Do you remember the initial scenario?"

Hyunsung smiled wryly at Heewon's question and looked at the bridge.

"How could I forget?"

"Everyone almost died here, right?"

"Heewon-ssi wasn't at Dongho Bridge then, so how do you know?"

"I've heard it countless times."

Heewon had begun the scenario elsewhere. But she, too, had read Han Sooyoung's story and knew well how Kim Dokja survived the initial scenario.

Trying to remember that time, Heewon extended her finger and asked.

"The bridge collapsed around there, right?"

"Yes."

"I heard there was an even-numbered bridge, a bridge only two people could cross."

Hyunsung nodded. His eyes were strangely focused, as if recalling the scene from that day.

"Gilyoung and I crossed the bridge together."

"I heard Myungoh Ahjussi carried Sangah-ssi and ran away."

"I really wanted to throw him into the river back then, but I held back."

The two chuckled at the mention of Han Myungoh's name, a name they hadn't heard in a long time.

Looking at the intact bridge, the two continued their conversation. About Yoo Sangah, about Lee Gilyoung, about Han Myungoh.

"And…"

Then, the scenes they remembered seemed to overlap over the intact bridge. The collapsed bridge. The menacing roar of an ichthyosaur. A man in a coat stood beside the precariously broken railing. Knowing it was a hallucination, the two held their breath and focused on the scene. Now, they desperately sketched out the story that only the three of them remembered in this world.

"The two were fighting over there, right?"

"They didn't fight, they just got hit."

"I wonder if Joonghyuk-ssi is doing well."

"I'm sure he's doing well. He's a strong man, isn't he?"

The two thought about a man. A regressor, stronger than anyone else in this world, and that's why he couldn't give up on this story until the very end.

"I wonder if he found him."

The wind blew again, and the scenery they'd remembered scattered. Countless cars honked their horns as they passed over the intact Dongho Bridge.

Hyunsung licked his lips.

"I hope he finds him."

"You really think so?"

Hyunsung hesitated, then nodded. Then Heewon spoke.

"Then what becomes of us who chose this ending?"

Perhaps it was a question she'd been holding back all along.

"Hyunsung-ssi, do you actually think we were wrong?"

Did the group who chose the ending where they didn't find Kim Dokja make it safely?

「Perhaps the ending they didn't choose wasn't the 'proper ending' of this story?」

Hyunsung was about to say something when a booming voice came from afar. It was Wukong's.

"Youngest—where are you—!"

Hyunsung and Heewon smiled bitterly, looked at each other, and ran toward Oksu Station.

Finding Wukong wasn't difficult. He stood at the station entrance, loudly searching for Kim Dokja. Heewon scolded him.

"A kid who left home on his own won't come running if you call him that way."

"What are you talking about? There's no way he wouldn't come if I called him."

Heewon shook her head.

"I don't think he's here. Did he go to another area?"

"No, he's here."

"How would you know?"

"I smell the Youngest."

Wukong calmly surveyed the area and said.

"He walked over there."

"Are you sure?"

"I'm sure."

"How can you be sure when you can't use skills or stigmata anymore?"

"…"

"We're just ordinary people now. You're no longer a myth-grade constellation."

"Just trust me."

Despite Heewon's rebuke, Wukong remained firmly convinced. With no other options, the group followed Wukong past Oksu Station and into the Geumho Station area. Wukong, who had been sniffing, said.

"This way."

"Exactly the direction of the scenario."

If Wukong's judgment was correct, Kim Dokja was currently moving precisely along the area where the scenario occurred.

It was then that Heewon, who had stopped dead in her tracks, spoke.

"Great Sage Heaven's Equal."

Wukong's ears twitched slightly as he walked ahead. Heewon, looking at the back of Wukong's head, asked.

"You said this world was created by Dokja-ssi's imagination?"

"Yes."

"Then what would happen if Dokja-ssi really yearned for that 'world' again?"

Wukong stopped.

"That couldn't be."

"How could you know?"

"It was a difficult ending; there's no way he would want to relive that story again."

"Is this world really the ending Dokja-ssi wanted to see? Do you truly believe that?"

Wukong slowly turned around. The moment she saw Wukong's distorted expression, Heewon was momentarily speechless.

Wukong asked.

"Why are you asking that now?"

His distorted face seemed both filled with rage and boundless sorrow.

*Tsutsutsu.*

And then, from somewhere, a familiar sound came. The three, their faces pale, turned to each other.

"No way, that was it."

Perhaps they misheard. But what if they heard correctly?

"We have to find Dokja-ssi, immediately."

Heewon, who had taken a hasty step ahead, stumbled violently.

"Heewon-ssi!"

Startled, Hyunsung supported Heewon. Feeling severely dizzy, Heewon frowned and leaned against him.

"It's okay."

Hyunsung, as if remembering something, looked around. This was Geumho Station. This was where Heewon had begun her full-scale scenario.

"We shouldn't have come here after all."

"No. That's not it…"

The tragedies of Geumho Station had long since faded from her mind. Sure, memories of this place had once tormented her, but now, long enough to let all those emotions flow with time, the dizziness she felt now wasn't due to those memories.

"Something feels off."

The moment she entered Geumho Station, a strange hallucination invaded Heewon's mind. The image of a blond man, faintly white, floated before her eyes.

Heewon knew who he was. But why was his face popping up now?

Wukong, watching Heewon, said.

"The Youngest is nearby."

"Wait—"

Wukong ignored Heewon's words and started running. As he entered the station platform, a crowd of people awaited him.

Cameras were waiting everywhere. Staff members were bustling about.

"Uh, uh, you can't come in!"

Someone approached and stopped Wukong.

"We're filming! Please step back!"

"Filming?"

"Yes. We're filming a movie."

Why now, here? A strange feeling came over him.

"The Youngest is in here."

As Wukong recklessly entered the scene, a staff member, lost in thought, shouted.

"Stop that guy!"

The staff rushed to stop Wukong. But Wukong swiftly dodged them all and sniffed again. The Youngest's scent lingered.

「He's inside the tunnel.」

Wukong frowned as he checked the empty underpass. It was a subway track. They were filming, but how could they possibly stop the subway for that reason?

*Tsutsutsu.*

Without hesitation, Wukong jumped down onto the tracks.

"What the heck, how did this guy get in?"

Even inside the tunnel, filming continued. People who looked like extras were strewn throughout the tunnel. They were covered in blood. Their makeup was so convincing that some of them looked like their limbs had been torn apart.

"Youngest!"

Walking through the eerie set, Wukong searched for the Youngest.

"Where are you! Youngest!"

He knew he wouldn't come out if he called him. That's just the kind of guy the Youngest is.

「A guy who demands another hair if you give him one.」

"Youngest!"

「A guy who hates the constellations and refuses to let any star stand behind him.」

"Kim Dokja!"

「A lonely guy.」

"Dokja! I'm here!"

Every time he saw his back, he wanted to be his guardian angel. He wanted to light his path with starlight. He wanted to let him know what lay ahead, what obstacles he had to avoid.

"Block him!"

A crowd of people burst out of nowhere, blocking his path. With nowhere left to run in the narrow tunnel, Wukong had no choice but to use his strength.

"Get out of the way."

A thud, a crushing sound echoed from his swinging fist. A terrified scream. The camera shutter sounded. Wukong continued to run through the tunnel, knocking down every man who charged at him. Wukong gradually lost track of who was a character in a movie and who was an outsider. It was as if he couldn't tell how much of this world was fiction and how much was fact.

Running along that dark road, Wukong imagined the Geumho Station tunnel where Kim Dokja would have run.

Kim Dokja, who had taken down gophers alongside his companions. Kim Dokja, who had risked his life to execute the scenario. Kim Dokja, who had fought to save his companions and received the support of the constellations. Kim Dokja, who had coughed up blood and spilled stories, yet never gave up.

"Youngest."

His breath caught in his throat. As he raced through the tunnel in his human form, Wukong began to understand Kim Dokja's feelings.

And the closer he got to that feeling, the more he realized.

Even though he had been watching Kim Dokja for so long, he still didn't quite know who Kim Dokja was.

「Isn't it possible that all stars are blinded by their own light, unable to see clearly what they're reflecting?」

The Youngest's scent was growing stronger. Across the pitch-black tunnel, he saw someone standing.

"That's incredible. I really didn't think you'd come this far."

A face he recognized appeared in the pale darkness.

Wukong gasped, glaring at the man before asking,

"What are you?"

"You already knew, didn't you?"

He was an interviewer for a security firm.

He'd thought something was off from the moment he first saw him. But since the Youngest was such a strange person, he'd been complacent, assuming such a person could exist in his imagination.

But now he saw it wasn't. All his senses were ringing with a strong alarm.

The man before him—

「It is clearly an existence from outside this 'world'.」

The interviewer shrugged.

"You can't go any further. This isn't your authorized record."

"Where's the Youngest?"

"He wants to go outside this 'world'."

"I can't allow that."

"You have no right to stop him."

"Yes. I'm his older brother."

For a moment, a faint pity flashed across the interviewer's eyes.

"That's why you couldn't be his 'sponsor'. You still have no idea what he's thinking."

"Shut up. If you don't hand over the Youngest immediately—"

"Oldest Liberator."

A crash, like a large building collapsing somewhere, was heard. People screamed from afar. A subway horn honked. An ominous feeling filled him.

"How long do you think you can keep him trapped in your 'prison'?"

Someone was trying to create a 'scenario' in this world.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 987 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (8)

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Hyunsung draped his arm over Heewon's shoulder, his eyes scanning the area with mounting urgency. A sharp, metallic stench assaulted his nose. The sounds of a panicked evacuation filled the air. There were sudden, jagged screams. How long had it been since he last witnessed a scene of such primal chaos?

Hyunsung, his muscles coiling with an instinctive tension, called out to Heewon.

"Heewon-ssi."

To make matters worse, Heewon’s state was visibly deteriorating. Normally, a veteran like her wouldn't be incapacitated by simple dizziness.

Tsutsutsu.

Hyunsung felt the resonance of a story vibrating through Heewon’s form. A faint spark of probability crackled within that narrative. But that was a logical impossibility. No scenarios existed in this worldline. There was no probability here, no lingering aftershocks.

「A long time ago, Kim Dokja had explained this phenomenon to me.」

Hyunsung’s pupils dilated, shimmering with a violent ripple. It felt as if a circuit, long ago severed, was being forcibly reconnected. Startled, Hyunsung tightened his grip on

Heewon’s shoulder once more.

"Heewon-ssi?"

Heewon lifted her head and brushed Hyunsung’s hand away with a sharp motion.

"Ah."

Hyunsung met her gaze and found himself frozen in his tracks.

The Heewon standing before him was undeniably the woman he knew. She was the longtime comrade who had bled beside him through countless scenarios. She was the warrior who swung her sword at his back, acting as the group’s ultimate shield. She was the person he vowed to protect above all others.

But why? The presence radiating from her now felt like that of a complete stranger.

Another explosion thundered from deep within Geumho Station, where Wukong had disappeared.

"Dokja-ssi."

Heewon whispered Kim Dokja’s name and sprinted toward the station entrance. Hyunsung, shaking off his stupor, scrambled to chase after her.

---

【Did he not claim he would refuse to record this?】

【Strictly speaking, this does not qualify as a 'record' in the traditional sense.】

---

Wukong inhaled slowly, surveying his surroundings.

「The 'scenario' has not yet commenced.」

That indicated the youngest had not yet truly manifested a desire for that 'world'.

"You have certainly done an admirable job of keeping him concealed."

The interviewer, maintaining his usual pace, continued to ramble before him.

"I invested a significant amount of effort into locating him. The existence of a world that escapes even the eyes of a 'Recorder' is truly a feat."

"…"

"But even your efforts cannot obstruct the arrival of a predestined [Fate]."

Fate. Hearing that word for the first time in an eternity, Wukong mused: So, there truly is such a thing as destiny.

"There is."

"Indeed. This entire world is currently being documented, yet—"

"It has already been recorded. You truly seem to relish these tedious monologues."

Wukong stuck his pinky into his ear, his expression one of pure boredom. The interviewer's brow furrowed as he spoke.

"This is hardly the time for such nonchalance. I am not the only entity that has discovered this reality."

"So?"

"It means your era of hiding him has reached its conclusion. Now, countless deities will descend upon this worldline to claim Kim Dokja."

"The Youngest? Why?"

"Because the entire universe hungers to complete 'One Perfect Dream'."

Wukong faltered. One Perfect Dream.

Eons ago, there was a time when Wukong, too, harbored such a dream. It was a story from an age when he craved ■■ more than anyone else in existence.

"You, too, should awaken from your fantasies. You no longer need to spend your life guarding an incomplete shard of a god."

"…"

"King of the Stone Monkeys, why do you remain shackled to the past? Does the sight of him merely serve as a reminder of your history? Are you simply projecting everything you failed to protect onto him?"

The interviewer took a step forward, spreading his arms wide.

"I invite you to join me. Cease being a prisoner of that golden headband. Set the imprisoned fragment of the deity free."

"…"

"I recognize that there is a purpose to living within this flawed delusion. But is this world not truly the one you once envisioned? Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, you are no longer a 'prisoner of the long-lost world'. Why have you confined yourself to this reality with the stories you once loved? It is unnecessary. The dreams you sought can be preserved in an eternal record. If you assist me—"

"I recall seeing someone who spoke exactly like you at the Gourmet Association."

Cracking his neck, Wukong abruptly cut the interviewer off.

"You’re such a pathetic brat that it took me a moment to place the face."

The interviewer’s expression hardened subtly. Wukong continued, his tone thick with mockery.

"You’re still just as talkative as ever, Asmodeus."

A faint spark crackled through the interviewer's body as his true name was unveiled.

"I was unaware that you, a mere Narrative-grade constellation, would ascend to the rank of 'Recorder'. Was this the path you chose to complete your ■■?"

After a momentary pause, Asmodeus chuckled. Then, with a heavy sigh, he posed a question.

"How did you identify me? You are currently unable to wield the power of stories."

"There are very few people who possess a tongue as long as our Youngest's."

"That is a truly loathsome compliment."

"So, what is your specific objective? Are you planning to abduct our Youngest to finalize your desired record, or something of that nature?"

"Judging by your tone, I suspect you have no intention of cooperating peacefully."

"Would you?"

"Then there is no further point in debate."

At Asmodeus's signal, men in black suits materialized behind him.

"Foolish Monkey King, this world is not the <Star Stream>."

The men lunged forward, using their weight to overpower Wukong. Crushed beneath their collective mass, Wukong's head was slammed into the dirt.

A world where neither stories nor skills could be invoked. Even for Wukong, it was a physical impossibility to shake off four men twice his size.

Yet, while pinned to the ground, Wukong broke into a fit of laughter.

"What do you find so amusing?"

"Because it's actually funny."

"Understand the situation. This is who you are now. You've discarded your dignity only to struggle within a meager mortal shell. That is the current reality of the once-proud and powerful Heavenly King."

Asmodeus approached slowly, as if taunting the Monkey King trapped beneath the Five Elements Mountain. He bowed low before the pinned Wukong and whispered.

"I am offering you one final opportunity. Cooperate with me."

"You keep babbling about cooperation…"

Wukong, still pressed against the ground, slowly tilted his head up.

"It seems you've failed to convince our Youngest."

"…"

"Well, if you had succeeded, a snake like you wouldn't be here begging me for help."

"…"

"What did the Youngest tell you? He said he wouldn't go anywhere without me, didn't he?"

Asmodeus stared at Wukong with hollow eyes for a long moment before standing. He gazed into the shadows of the damp underground tunnel.

"This location is a fitting site for the tomb of a Fallen Monkey King."

A young man waiting in the rear unsheathed a short blade. Asmodeus nodded.

The young man, receiving the command, prepared to plunge the knife into Wukong's neck when...

"You have intruded into this world."

Wukong's laughter vanished.

"Do you truly believe you are the first?"

"What—"

Wukong inhaled sharply. He drew in more and more air. He continued to breathe as if attempting to drain the entire atmosphere, and the oxygen in the tunnel suddenly felt dangerously thin. Asmodeus, startled, recoiled and shouted.

"Kill him! Now!"

But the moment the young man lunged with the knife, Wukong's left arm slipped from its restraints. His fist shot out with surgical precision, swerving past the blade's arc to shatter the young man's jaw. The man's body crumpled and hit the floor with a dull thud.

"What…?"

Asmodeus scowled.

This shouldn't be possible. The men he had employed were elite recruits, specifically selected from high-end security agencies.

But Wukong, as if dismantling a simple toy, began to unbind the other men by precisely folding their joints.

"What— what is this—"

"Kwaaaaak! My arm!"

Asmodeus, remaining poised, signaled the rest.

"Everyone, attack."

Immediately, the remaining men charged as one. Asmodeus had brought reinforcements just for such an occasion.

Armed with stun guns and segmented staffs, they surrounded Wukong from every angle. For Wukong, trapped in a normal body, it was an insurmountable obstacle.

But Wukong, without a hint of stress, began to swing his fists with a dry efficiency.

Thud, crunch!

The sounds of impact and breaking bone echoed in rapid succession. It was a display of dull, brutal violence.

A minute later, only one man remained standing in the shadows of the tunnel.

"Is that the end of it?"

In the darkness, Wukong's eyes flared with a blazing golden light.

Asmodeus shook his head in pure disbelief.

"How... in a worldline devoid of a system—"

"Have you forgotten? I was always strong, system or not."

Only then did Asmodeus truly grasp the nature of the man before him.

「He is the Great Heavenly King. The legendary Monkey King who stood alone against the <Emperor>.」

Wukong's shadow stretched across Asmodeus as he strode forward.

"I told you, I'm confident in a fight."

Asmodeus finally realized he was in danger and turned to flee, but Wukong was instantly upon him. Asmodeus's knees and arms buckled as the force of the blow connected.

"Ugh."

Even Asmodeus couldn't suppress a groan of agony beneath the swift, savage strike.

Wukong leaned in.

"Where is the Youngest?"

Despite the blinding pain, Asmodeus let out a twisted smile.

"Even so, you cannot stop what is coming."

"Hmm, is that so? You think you haven't been hit enough?"

"Because he is currently summoning every version of Kim Dokja from the 'Snowfield'."

At the mention of the snowfield, Wukong's expression froze for a heartbeat.

Asmodeus continued.

"I asked you what security meant. I am truly curious. Just how far can you protect him with that frail body…"

With those final words, Asmodeus collapsed forward.

Wukong frowned, muttering to himself.

"What is wrong with you, you punk?"

A faint tremor vibrated through the soles of his feet. Then, a familiar scent reached his nostrils. Wukong's head snapped up.

"Youngest."

Wukong sprinted toward the source of the scent. He covered dozens of meters through the tunnel. There he was—the Youngest, unconscious and lashed to the empty railroad tracks.

"Youngest! Are you okay? I'm here! Your eldest brother is here!"

Kim Dokja did not respond.

"Hahaha, hahahahahaha—!"

Asmodeus's laughter echoed from the darkness. The vibrations in the ground were intensifying by the second.

Gripped by a dark premonition, Wukong frantically tore at the knots binding Kim Dokja.

But the rope was tied with such complexity that the knot refused to yield.

Asmodeus's laughter abruptly cut off. The sound of tearing metal and structural destruction rose. A blinding light flooded the tunnel.

「It was the subway.」

A train, a force capable of shredding anything in its path, was hurtling toward them.

The Youngest's body remained still, as if he were part of the tracks themselves. Wukong had no blade to cut the ropes.

The Great Sage, Heaven's Equal stood his ground.

「Can I do it?」

Watching the approaching subway, Wukong took another deep breath. His muscles twitched and expanded.

He possessed no power of stories, no stigma, and no skills. He only had a body slightly more robust than a commoner's. Could that possibly be enough to halt a mass of speeding steel? Before he could think, the subway was upon them. Resolved, Wukong planted his feet. He wouldn't know the limit until he pushed it. If he could just shield the Youngest—

「There is no way that will work.」

He thought he was hallucinating. Then, he felt a powerful shove. The world spun as he was thrown toward the edge of the tunnel wall. A blood-stained subway train roared past his eyes.

He blinked, disoriented, as a figure stood beside him, gasping for air.

"Youngest?"

The Youngest had regained consciousness. Somehow, Kim Dokja had broken free from the tracks and managed to push him to safety.

Wukong, his heart hammering in his chest, checked the Youngest for injuries.

But the moment he met the Youngest's eyes, he knew something was fundamentally wrong.

"You…"

He had observed Kim Dokja longer than anyone, since the very dawn of the scenarios. He was certain. The body before him belonged to the Youngest.

But,

"Who are you?"

The consciousness inhabiting the Youngest’s body was not the 'Youngest' he knew.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 988 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (9)

His head was spinning.

「It's already been eight years since I entered this world.」

Throughout those eight years, Wukong had repeated the same routines every single day. He ate what the youngest ate and wore what the youngest wore. Immersed in this human existence, Wukong wondered what kind of world the youngest had truly dreamed of.

「Is this the 'ordinary life' the youngest sought?」

Wukong couldn't be certain. He had never experienced this kind of 'ordinary life' to begin with.

To him, existence had always been a bloody battlefield—a struggle between constellations vying for legends, a coliseum of stars observing prized incarnations.

「"But wasn't I twenty-eight last year?"」

A mere eight years. To the stars, it was but a fleeting moment. To Wukong, who had been entombed beneath the Five Elements Mountain for centuries, it was a blink of an eye. Yet, in those eight years, Wukong had learned and mastered a great deal.

「"But wouldn't it be nice to stay twenty-eight?"」

Now, Wukong could think with a human heart. He understood human desires and had learned to live like one of them.

He learned these lessons from Hyunsung and Heewon: the necessity of earning a living, the respect for others' property, and the profound value of sharing time with someone.

As he savored every moment of his mortal life, Wukong finally felt he had moved a step closer to the youngest's life. But...

「"What are you talking about? I can't stay twenty-eight forever. The stories I love will just stay there."」

Perhaps the youngest truly wanted to escape this world he had protected for so long.

"I'm asking. Who are you?"

The being who had occupied the youngest's body did not respond.

He feared it might be Asmodeus or some other interloper, but he sensed no such malice within the youngest's body.

He detected a faint magical energy, but it bore no resemblance to the demon kings he knew. It was more like the lingering scent of an old book.

A fragrance that brushed against the deep recesses of his mind, like a long-forgotten memory box.

Wukong frowned instinctively and asked, "Are you possessed?"

Kim Dokja, his shoulders hunched weakly, offered no answer.

"Tell me. How did you break through the prison? How did you take over the youngest's body?"

「There can be no 'possessor' capable of possessing the youngest.」

The youngest was the very foundation of this world; its essence was rooted in his imagination.

To usurp the youngest's body, one would need an imagination surpassing even his own, or be a being whose soul was fundamentally identical.

"If you don't answer."

Wukong seized Kim Dokja by the collar, his voice burning with intensity.

"I'll kill you."

A faint, burgeoning murderous aura saturated the surroundings. But Kim Dokja remained silent, his eyes hollow. Watching the youngest, Wukong's anger slowly mounted.

「It was a world we had worked so hard to protect.」

He did not know who this man was. But if the youngest had been harmed in some unknown way, or if that was why this world was being threatened...

「It was the only worldline where the youngest's dream could come true.」

Wukong, his eyes narrowed, gripped Kim Dokja by the collar and raised his other hand.

"That's enough."

A cold blade brushed the back of Wukong's neck. Wukong knew the bite of that steel well.

"Put Dokja-ssi down."

Wukong scowled and turned his head.

"What the hell are you?"

It was the Heewon he knew—the family who had taught him how to live as a human for the past eight years.

That same family was currently pointing a knife at him.

"If you don't release him by the count of three, I'll cut you. One."

It was Heewon's voice and Heewon's face. But the moment he sensed the shimmering stories within those eyes, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, realized.

This wasn't Heewon.

"Look at this."

Wukong's muscles rippled with irritation.

"This is starting to piss me off. What the hell are you people?"

From the youngest to Heewon. As unprecedented events unfolded in rapid succession, Wukong's patience finally reached its limit.

From afar, Hyunsung shouted, "No! You must not fight!"

Wukong and Heewon's eyes locked, and in the next heartbeat, their hands moved. Sharp steel met clenched fists.

Whoosh.

A soft vibration echoed. It was a familiar resonance, but it stopped Wukong dead in his tracks.

Because it was a vibration that should have never occurred.

In an instant, Wukong put distance between himself and the youngest, reaching into his clothes to pull out his phone.

「The youngest's smartphone was ringing.」

It shouldn't have been possible. The phone was always kept on 'airplane mode'.

—Caller ID blocked.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, answered. Soon, a voice came through the line.

A sensation of peace and comfort. When I opened my eyes, I was lying in a cozy bed. I couldn't remember how long it had been since my last awakening. Staring up at the impossibly white ceiling, I blinked in a daze.

I wondered if everything had been a dream. But I knew that couldn't be true.

「"I asked, who are you?"」

A voice suddenly surfaced in my mind, and memories of the past came crashing back like a storm.

「I jumped into the 'Missing Bush' with Jung Heewon to find Dansu ahjussi.」

And then I arrived in the worldline where the 'Third Kim Dokja' resided. My final memory was of regaining consciousness in this body and shoving the Great Sage away from the subway tracks.

"Are you awake?"

The door creaked open, and a tall, blond man appeared.

"Ah."

I unconsciously rubbed my eyes, overcome by a sense of unreality.

「Great Sage Heaven's Equal, Sun Wukong, was there.」

The constellation that had integrated all of his stories to become the 'Oldest Liberator'.

One of the four veterans of the early channel, who had once bestowed the epithet 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' upon Kim Dokja.

「These aren't my feelings.」

I knew it. This was my first time seeing the Great Sage in person. Nevertheless, a part of my heart throbbed.

「He chose this worldline and has always protected Kim Dokja.」

As a fragment of Kim Dokja, I could understand: how much the third Kim Dokja relied on and adored him, and how long he had been a member of this family.

「Kim Dokja wasn't an only child in this world.」

Amidst a whirlwind of longing, envy, and an inexplicable sense of fulfillment, I looked at the Great Sage, unsure of what to say.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, watched me and scratched his cheek with an embarrassed expression.

"You're the 'youngest' from another world!"

"Oh, yes. Let me introduce myself first. I—"

I was momentarily speechless. Who should I claim to be?

The Great Sage chuckled at my confusion.

"Kim Dokja, of course."

"Yes."

That's right. I am 'Kim Dokja' now. But I was not the Kim Dokja the Great Sage knew. Oddly enough, that fact stung a corner of my heart.

"I'm sorry. There was a misunderstanding. I heard the general story from this guy."

The Great Sage was gripping a smartphone. The Great Sage and a smartphone? It seemed like an odd combination, but looking closer, I saw a name on the screen.

「Demon King of Salvation.」

It seemed the 'Demon King of Salvation' had called while I was asleep.

"Dokja-ssi! Are you awake?"

A thud sounded from behind the door, and Jung Heewon's face peeked through. She shoved the Great Sage aside, entered the room, and seized my hand.

"Are you hurt? What the hell is this, really?"

I stared at Jung Heewon quietly. The scars on her face and her attire were strangely different from the Heewon I knew in the 41st round.

But the story I felt vibrating inside her was definitely the 'Mad Sword Emperor' I knew.

"Heewon-ssi, did you really enter that body?"

"Yes, when I woke up, this was the state I was in."

Jung Heewon clenched and unclenched her fists repeatedly, her expression one of disbelief.

"She really is a strong body. Unbelievably so."

I suppose so. Jung Heewon in the 1,864th round was the pinnacle of her potential.

"It's a shame I can't use stories or her skills. I'd like to try it out."

I smiled bitterly at her words.

The moment I possessed this worldline, I immediately realized what kind of place it was.

In this world, the power of the 'System' cannot be invoked.

Not stories, not stigma, not skills. The unique powers allowed by the <Star Stream> were strictly controlled here, just like the 'reality' we once knew.

"It's fortunate that we can't use them."

"Huh? Why?"

"Because if that were possible, we would be in real danger."

I vaguely recalled the fight between Asmodeus and the Great Sage just before I passed out.

Even in this world with its limited systems, Asmodeus could plot such a bold scheme. If the Great Sage's body hadn't been abnormally strong, I would have been dragged away without a fight.

"There are others besides us who know the coordinates of this worldline."

I recalled the information I'd heard from the Recorder of Fear, Hermit, in the 'Records Archives'.

「Emperor. Monkey. Sword and shield.」

He had provided those keywords regarding the worldline related to the Third Kim Dokja. His keywords likely referred to this world.

The Emperor and the monkey represented the Great Sage Heaven's Equal. The sword and shield referred to Heewon and Hyunsung.

Hermit had already implied that the coordinates of this place were known to a select few. That's right—

"I know that."

The Great Sage, who had been listening to my story, nodded.

"You're not the first to come here."

"Not the first time."

I wanted to ask if he knew anyone else who had visited, but my question remained unanswered. Another man appeared at the doorway, a puff of steam rising from his face.

"Are you awake?"

A polite yet profound voice.

I got goosebumps again.

「Lee Hyunsung, the Steel Sword Emperor.」

Lee Hyunsung, the man I'd always admired from <Kim Dokja Company>, was right there.

He glanced at Jung Heewon, who was holding my hand with a somewhat dark expression, and placed a steaming bowl before me.

"I made some porridge."

"Oh, thank you."

"Eat it while it's still warm."

I hesitantly picked up my spoon. Come to think of it, I was quite hungry.

"Well... excuse me."

I took a small sip.

The hot rice melted in my mouth. It was delicious and perfectly seasoned porridge. It wasn't as exquisite as Yoo Joonghyuk's cooking, but it was a delicate dish that spoke of the chef's dedication.

The three of them watched me silently for a while as I ate. The Great Sage looked impressed, and Jung Heewon seemed relieved. Lee Hyunsung's face was strangely somber, yet his eyes shone with joy.

After I finished the bowl, Lee Hyunsung finally spoke.

"I'd like to ask you a few questions."

"Yes."

"Are you from the worldline chosen by the other comrades?"

As expected, Hyunsung seemed to have already guessed my origin.

I nodded and answered.

"Yes."

"I see."

Lee Hyunsung asked again, his expression grave.

"Are they... well?"

For a moment, I didn't know how to respond. It seemed Hyunsung knew nothing of the group's fate in other worlds. Given the limited system here, this wasn't surprising.

"I don't know either. I've only seen them a few times."

"Is that so?"

Hyunsung's face darkened further. Seeing him like that was heartbreaking, and I wanted to say something—to write a single line of comfort, even if it was a lie.

I hesitated for a moment before speaking.

"But those people."

I didn't know what had happened to the members of <Kim Dokja Company> in the eight years I was gone. But even without knowing, there were things I could say.

"They haven't given up."

That's something I knew without needing to ask.

"They still haven't given up on anything."

Lee Hyunsung slowly raised his head, his eyes strangely bloodshot.

He licked his lips several times, as if wanting to ask something else. But even with his large frame, he seemed to find the question difficult to voice.

After biting his lip for a long time, Hyunsung finally opened his mouth, seemingly determined.

Tsutsutsu.

With a faint spark, Jung Heewon, who had been sitting beside him, collapsed onto the bed.

"Heewon-ssi!"

Lee Hyunsung and I checked her pulse simultaneously. Her eyelids were trembling unsteadily. The Great Sage approached and quickly examined her complexion.

"It's a side effect of the 'broken film theory'."

I quickly understood the situation. Right now, the Jung Heewon from the 41st and 1,864th rounds were coexisting in that body.

"This can't last long."

When two essentially identical souls coexist in a single body, their memory films become hopelessly entangled.

"Both souls have too strong an ego. If this continues, the body will not be able to withstand the collision and will collapse."

If one soul could naturally merge with the other, it might be different, but in this situation, that wasn't happening.

Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal sighed deeply, looked at Jung Heewon, then back at me, and said in a grave voice,

"You must leave this world immediately."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 989 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (10)

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I understood the Great Sage’s intent. Jung Heewon and I shouldn't be in this world. Regardless of our intentions, we were uninvited guests, and our presence was the very catalyst for these anomalies.

"That can't be."

Even so, I couldn't leave. There was still someone I had to find here.

"If you stay, the Youngest will be in danger."

The Great Sage’s expression hardened, his voice dropping into a firm, low register.

"Every 'Kim Dokja' in the universe is currently in danger."

"..."

"You already know. Asmodeus has already infiltrated. The others could manifest at any moment."

"What exactly is their goal?"

"They are likely trying to recreate the 'Oldest Dream.' More accurately, an 'Oldest Dream' that suits their own tastes."

Whether they were 'Recorders' like Asmodeus or Myth-grade Constellations, their objective was clear: to collect the [Kim Dokja Fragments]. They intended to harness the power of the 'Oldest Dream' to reorganize the to their liking.

"We cannot allow them to complete even a single Kim Dokja."

「 "Because he is calling all the Kim Dokjas from the 'Snowfield'." 」

If Asmodeus's words were true, it was highly likely that my brother had already interfered with this worldline. Despite the warning, the Great Sage continued to stare me down with a blunt, piercing gaze.

"So, what is your purpose? To stop them?"

"Yes."

"How?"

"That—"

"Are you also trying to collect the [Kim Dokja Fragments]?"

The Great Sage's eyes shone with a cold, golden light. I nodded, offering no denial.

"I am."

"Then how are you any different from them?"

Jung Heewon frowned at the Great Sage's accusation, her hand twitching toward her hilt, while Lee Hyunsung's eyes widened in surprise.

"I have no intention of becoming 'the only Kim Dokja'."

"You intend to collect the fragments, yet you don't want to become the 'One'?"

"Yes. In a way, I am similar to you."

"Similar to me? What do you mean by that?"

"Just because you became the 'Oldest Liberator'..."

I recalled the Great Sage's Fables. I remembered the various 'names' he had earned throughout the *Journey to the West*.

"The King of Mihu."

Once, he was the Stone Monkey King of Huaguo Mountain.

"The Bimawen."

He was once the humble stablekeeper of the Heavenly Realm.

"The Victorious Fighting Buddha."

He was the monk who escorted Xuanzang to the Western Heavens.

"And just as those names never truly disappear from the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal..."

He was a Constellation who had witnessed the story of an Incarnation to its very end.

「All those names were him.」

Even now, those stories—each possessing its own ego—must be flowing within the Great Sage. Just as the small Kim Dokjas gathered behind the [Fourth Wall] to watch the story, his "brothers" were likely watching this moment from within him.

"The reason I collect the fragments is not to become a single, absolute Kim Dokja."

I didn't expect to persuade him with shallow words. He knew 'Kim Dokja', but he didn't know *me*. To him, I was merely an intruder who had hijacked the body of his 'Youngest'. Still, I had to speak. It was the only tool I had left.

"I see. I understand."

After a moment of silent reflection, the Great Sage finally replied.

"You didn't come here to harm the Youngest. Is that what you're saying?"

He didn't press further or erupt in anger. Sensing the tide turning in my favor, I nodded quickly.

"That’s right."

"To prove that, you’ll first have to vacate the Youngest's body."

"That’s... difficult."

"Why?"

"Because without this vessel, I have no way to manifest in this world."

Truthfully, I hadn't chosen to inhabit this body either. It would be more accurate to say this body had *called* me.

"And more importantly... I can't sense the soul of the 'Kim Dokja' that originally resided in this body."

The Great Sage's expression shifted again. He must have vaguely sensed it too.

「 I possessed the 'Third Kim Dokja' through the [Disconnected Film Theory]. 」

My situation was similar to Jung Heewon's. However, unlike her, I wasn't suffering from the aftermath of Probability. This was because the 'Third Kim Dokja' wasn't fighting me for control. I was currently inhabiting an empty shell.

The Great Sage muttered, biting his lip.

"Damn it. I suspected as much."

The situation was clear.

「 Just before I took over this body, someone stole the soul of the 'Third Kim Dokja'. 」

I didn't know how they had managed it. Perhaps Asmodeus, or whoever gave the 'Book' to the Third, had orchestrated the soul's disappearance.

*Buzz. Buzz.*

Suddenly, my smartphone vibrated. It wasn't just mine. Jung Heewon, Lee Hyunsung, and the Great Sage all felt their phones buzz simultaneously.

I checked the message.

**[Terror Alert]**

Lee Hyunsung's face went pale as he scrolled through his screen.

"You... you need to see this."

We crowded around Lee Hyunsung's phone.

**—Name: Kim Wukong.**

The Great Sage’s ID photo was displayed in large print. Beneath it were two lines:

**—Status: Terrorist.**

**—Occupation: Unemployed, Age: Unknown.**

The Great Sage’s brow furrowed.

"These bastards...?"

The alerts kept coming. A closer look revealed that it wasn't just him; Lee Hyunsung and Jung Heewon had also been added to the terrorist watchlist under the same pretext.

"They're looking for the Youngest."

A heavy *thump* echoed from outside the door. We didn't need to open it to know who was there.

"They've arrived."

Lee Hyunsung, having clearly simulated this scenario a thousand times, began stacking furniture against the door.

"Please, go through the veranda. Take the escape chute and go straight down. Wukong-ssi will protect you."

"What about you, Hyunsung-ssi?"

"I’ll buy as much time as I can here."

I tried to protest, to tell him I couldn't leave him behind, but the Great Sage was already dragging me toward the balcony.

"It’s fine. He’s sturdier than I am."

The Great Sage checked the descent device, then simply leaped over the railing without even bothering with a harness. He looked back at Jung Heewon and nodded.

"I’ll clear the path below. You bring the Youngest."

"Wait! Use the equipment!"

"I don't know how to use that junk."

The Great Sage began sliding down the exterior wall of the building. His grip strength was terrifying; he maintained a perfectly constant speed as he descended. He was definitely beyond human standards. Then again, he *was* a monkey.

Jung Heewon strapped into the harness and opened her arms toward me.

"Let’s go, Dokja-ssi."

"Wait a moment."

When I hesitated, she tilted her head. "Why? What is it?"

I looked down. We were well over ten stories high. I turned to her with a very serious expression.

"On second thought, I think there might be another way."

"Another way?"

"Is it really necessary to flee like this? Maybe the people outside aren't enemies. If I just try to talk to them—"

Jung Heewon stared at me blankly before asking, "You’re not... afraid of heights, are you?"

"It’s not that."

"Get over here, quickly."

"Wait! You haven't forgotten there's no System here, right? If the cable snaps—"

Jung Heewon forcibly grabbed me and hooked us both to the line.

"Are we really doing this? This isn't rated for two people—!"

"We’re out of time. And..."

The descent began.

"It’s my first time using this thing, too."

I screamed internally as we plummeted. Below the apartment complex, men in black suits were already pointing toward the sky.

"There they are!"

"Whoa—!"

Before they could react, they were sent flying, struck in the back of the head by the Great Sage. But they were just the beginning. Black sedans were swarming the area, and more men in suits were closing in from every direction.

No matter how strong the Great Sage was, he couldn't fight an entire army without his divinity.

He watched them silently, then pulled a pipe from his pocket.

"You said you were looking for something, right?" he asked, blowing a puff of smoke.

"I'll help you for now."

"Are you sure?"

"But I'm not giving up the Youngest. My contract says I have to get him back."

I thought for a second and nodded. "Understood."

"Good. Contract established."

With those words, the Great Sage threw his pipe to the ground. A faint explosion followed, and thick, acrid smoke swallowed the area.

"What is this?!"

"Don't panic! It's just a smokescreen!"

"Gwaaaaakh!"

As expected, it wasn't just tobacco. The sound of rapid-fire strikes echoed through the fog. A moment later, a pitch-black sedan tore through the smoke and screeched to a halt. The back door flew open.

"Get in! Move!"

Jung Heewon and I scrambled inside. I never thought the day would come where I'd be in a getaway car driven by the Great Sage, Heaven's Equal.

"Thank you for the help."

"We’re helping each other."

*Helping each other.* Those words felt strangely heavy.

"Can you really trust me?" I asked.

I knew him because of the *Ways of Survival*, but to him, I was a total stranger. Yet he was risking everything for me.

"I don't know exactly who you are, but..." The Great Sage scratched his cheek, looking a bit embarrassed. "I quite like your hair."

Startled, I caught my reflection in the window. At some point, my hair had turned a shimmering golden color. It was likely the influence of Cheon Inho’s Fable.

*I suppose that guy is useful for something after all.*

We sped away from the apartment, leaving the confused suits behind in the smoke. As the building receded into the distance, a sudden pang of sadness hit me. Kim Dokja and these three had likely lived in that home for a long time.

"If you bring the real Kim Dokja back... will you go back to living there?"

"Probably."

"It's dangerous now."

"Is there anywhere in this world that *isn't*?"

I was left speechless. Where in this universe could anyone truly be 'safe'?

"No matter what, I will protect this world to the end," the Constellation who had illuminated this world alone declared. "Because this world is the 'home' the Youngest wanted to live in."

This world was the 'Large House' Kim Dokja had built for his companions. Perhaps he had planned to spend the rest of his eternity here with them.

I stared at the desolate landscape whipping past the window. "It’s a bit too big to be called a 'home'."

We drove through empty, ruined streets. The black sedans would be on our tail soon. Whoever was pulling the strings—Asmodeus or a Myth-grade Constellation from the

Round Table—they were manipulating the government of this world to hunt us down.

"This house is too big for you to protect by yourself."

No matter how strong he was, he had limits in a world without the System. He wouldn't want to admit it, but...

"Yes."

...Wait, what?

"I think we'll need some help this time."

To my surprise, the Great Sage admitted it readily. His voice turned grave.

"Hold on tight."

He slammed the accelerator, and the car roared forward. A thought suddenly occurred to me.

"Wait... do you even have a driver's license?"

"Isn't it basically the same as riding a cloud?"

After thirty minutes of high-speed weaving, we arrived at a massive, abandoned factory. Jung Heewon scanned the perimeter, her hand back on her sword.

"What is this place?"

"A prison."

The Great Sage parked the sedan haphazardly and strode toward the entrance. As he threw the doors open, a heavy tension filled the air, as if a giant beast were breathing in the shadows.

"I'm here!" the Great Sage shouted.

From the darkness came the rattling of heavy chains. The sound grew louder until an old man stepped into the faint light.

"What is it now?"

The old man had a thick iron collar around his neck, connected to a leash.

"Did you come to feed us, you damn monkey?"

He clearly knew the Great Sage. I studied him—he wore a weathered red Marine Corps cap and a tattered slogan T-shirt. He didn't look like a legendary ally.

The Great Sage chuckled. "What, you don't recognize them? You should know who they are."

"Huh?"

"I told you. This isn't their first time in this world."

I looked at the old man again. This time, I saw it—the faint, rhythmic shimmer of Fables emanating from him. Something deep inside me resonated with that power.

*Wait. It can't be.*

I looked at the Marine Corps cap again. Goosebumps broke out across my arms. It was impossible, and yet...

「 He is one of the three Great Gods of Olympus. 」

As if to confirm my suspicion, the Great Sage spoke.

"I need your help, Poseidon."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 990 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (11)

【Is this really the world the 'Oldest Dream' desired?】

The Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Seas—'Poseidon'.

I knew that name very well. In the main story, he was a myth-grade constellation who had fought against Hades. A star whose mere presence brought countless narrative-grade constellations to their knees.

He even appeared leading the <Olympus> warships during the Fear Realm.

The strange part was this.

"Why on earth is Poseidon here?"

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal replied in a casual tone, as if it were nothing unusual.

"I told you before. There are others here besides you."

I had heard that story. But I never expected it to refer to that 'Poseidon'.

"He must've been possessed like you. But he was a bit unlucky."

"The Three Gods of Olympus possessed the Korean Marines?"

"Yes."

"No, shouldn't they have been more careful when choosing their host?"

"Did you possess your host on your own?"

"That's not true, but—"

Even so, if it was Poseidon, shouldn't he have possessed someone like the Chief of Naval Operations at least?

As if he had read my thoughts, Poseidon cleared his throat.

"Even so, he's the incarnation of a general."

Hearing Poseidon speak with such solemn pride made me even less convinced, but I still forced myself to nod and ask.

"What's with that leash?"

"I put it on him. You can tell he's here to cause trouble."

I had a rough idea of what had happened. The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal must've subdued Poseidon the moment he entered this world and locked him up inside this abandoned factory.

"Damn it! If you're going to lock me up, at least feed me properly!"

"I came here to feed you."

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal grumbled and opened the supply closet near the entrance. Frozen groceries spilled out in a heap.

"Oh, did Hyunsung stock this yesterday?"

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal whistled as he pulled out a large pile of frozen groceries and loaded them onto the cart beside him.

"Here, eat."

Poseidon stared suspiciously at the groceries. Then he picked up a large chunk of meat and asked,

"What's this?"

"Frozen pork belly. Aren't you lucky today?"

"Frozen... pork belly?"

Eyes widening, Poseidon picked up another package beside it and asked again,

"Then what's this?"

"Frozen chicken. The Marines have PXs, right?"

"Frozen... chicken?"

Does he like it? Is Poseidon seriously enjoying the Frozen series right now?

Jung Heewon whispered to me in disbelief.

"Is that really the 'Poseidon' I know?"

"I think so."

I couldn't believe it either, but the ripples of the story were definitely the same as the 'Poseidon' I remembered.

We held our breath and eavesdropped on the conversation between the great mythological constellations.

"Is the microwave still broken?"

"It breaks sometimes, but it's fine."

"Then take all of this and eat it today. It's a bit past the expiration date, but it'll be fine. You know the difference between the expiration date and the best-before date, right?"

"Of course! Hahaha!"

Everything the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal had brought was so-called 'waste' that was already a week past its expiration date. Apparently Lee Hyunsung had recently brought it.

But... this seemed like far too much for one person to eat.

"But what are you doing today? Is it some kind of special day?"

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal shrugged and gently loosened the chain around Poseidon's neck.

"It'll be hard to eat with that on, so I'll unchain you. You can't run away, understand? If you leave the factory with that leash on—"

The moment he said that, Poseidon shoved the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal aside and bolted out of the factory. In the next instant, a powerful electric current shot from Poseidon's leash.

"It'll electrocute you."

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal returned, dragging Poseidon back as he writhed on the floor.

I poked Poseidon's charred neck and asked,

"Is this the constellation that's going to help us?"

"Yes."

Jung Heewon, who was beside me poking Poseidon's thigh with the tip of her sword, said,

"No matter how I look at him, he doesn't seem like he'll be much help."

I agreed, but Poseidon was still a myth-grade constellation. Even though he had been overpowered by the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, Poseidon might still possess some extraordinary ability. He's a Marine, so maybe he's a good shot... He is still a mythical being after all.

Then a sudden realization struck me that something was missing.

"Wait a moment, Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal."

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, who was pushing the cart and dragging Poseidon along, answered without turning around.

"What?"

"You said 'others' earlier, didn't you?"

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal had definitely said this.

「There are already others here besides you.」

'Others' who had already arrived.

According to the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal's explanation, 'Poseidon' wasn't the only one who had arrived before us.

"Could it be that he's not the only one?"

At that moment, a piece of information flashed through my mind.

「Something's wrong with the constellations in the higher scenarios.」

Was it when I was talking with the Recorders, or when I was wandering through the 'New Murim District'? I was certain I had heard something like that before.

Even putting the 'Great Destruction Scenario', 'Ragnarok', aside, the constellations had been worried about something.

「What if the 'problem' troubling the constellations was related to this world?」

Instead of answering, the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal simply continued pushing the cart forward. As he reached the inner gate of the factory, a commotion could be heard from somewhere inside. The door creaked open, and the people sitting inside all turned to look at him at the same time.

「Everyone was wearing a leash.」

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I took a quick tour of the abandoned factory with the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal. Small smart-farm facilities were installed throughout the factory, though they seemed to have stopped operating at some point. I was somewhat impressed by how well-maintained everything was, so I asked.

"Are you farming here?"

"I suppose you could call it that."

Vegetables like lettuce and butterhead lettuce were growing. Fruits like strawberries could also be seen here and there.

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal muttered while checking the condition of the vegetables and fruits.

"It's annoying considering the purpose, but I can't just let them starve to death. Honestly, I don't think the Youngest would want that either. And it might be useful someday."

This wasn't some kind of 'Farming Scenario'. It was a group of myth-grade constellations gathered together to run a smart farm. If I went back and told Kim Anna about this, she'd definitely think I was lying again.

"What's that?"

"Oh, that."

A basket filled with wooden sculptures created by skilled hands was piled high. Some looked like Thor, while others looked like the Great Sage, Heaven's Equal.

The Great Sage, Heaven's Equal examined one of the sculptures of himself and spoke.

"Some of them have absolutely no talent for farming. They have to earn money some other way."

"Are you selling these?"

"Do you think they wouldn't sell?"

"No, I think there would be demand…"

"Right? Originally I was planning to have Heewon post them on social media next month and promote them—"

"So you weren't unemployed?"

The Great Sage, Heaven's Equal pursed his lips as if wronged.

"I'm not that guy in black, so how could I be unemployed?"

The Great Sage, Heaven's Equal, once a stable keeper in the heavens, had now become a guard watching over the star prison in this world. Though... was 'guard' really the right word? Come to think of it, I wasn't sure what job title would fit.

"Businessman."

While we were touring the abandoned factory, Poseidon, who had fainted earlier, woke up and was chatting with the other prisoners.

"Look! The monkey gave me this today!"

"Oh—"

"It's frozen pork belly!"

Exclamations erupted from all around. Most of them were elderly men.

Surely they weren't all myth-grade constellations, were they? The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, who had been watching them from afar, muttered quietly.

"I don't know if you recognize him, but the guy in the corner is Odin."

Odin? Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father', the ruler of Asgard?

I turned my head toward where the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal was pointing. In front of an old stove in the corner sat an old man wearing small glasses. He was hunched over, completely absorbed in something. Looking closer, he was carving wood.

Were those carvings Odin's work?

"Hey, Odin. It's time to eat."

Poseidon approached him, and Odin raised his head with an annoyed expression.

"Don't call me by that name."

"If I don't call you Odin, what else should I call you?"

"M-My name is Oh Jintaek."

As if struggling to remember, Odin answered with a slurred voice. Poseidon immediately snapped back, "You damned idiot, are you already losing your mind? You're a myth-grade constellation! You're Odin, the king of Asgard!"

Despite Poseidon's shouting, Odin simply shook his head and returned to carving the wood.

Poseidon then pulled out something like a recorder from his pocket and pointed it toward us.

"Don't you see the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal over there? Have you really forgotten everything? He trapped us, myth-grade constellations, in this place!"

Odin turned his empty gaze toward me. He looked at the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, then at me standing beside him, and slowly shook his head again.

"There's no such thing as the <Star Stream>."

It was truly a strange conversation, unlike anything that had ever happened in the <Star Stream>.

Perhaps noticing my gaze, the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal cleared his throat and added, "Even if they look like that, a myth is still a myth. It's because I'm using this body that I was able to easily subdue them and keep them in check."

I nodded.

Even if they would die soon, a myth was still a myth. If I could just get their help, confronting the threats of this world wouldn't be impossible.

"Let go! You damned bastard!"

"You old man!"

The problem was how to control that chaotic group.

"Old men, stop fighting and gather together!"

At that moment, a middle-aged man suddenly shouted.

"It's time for the story reading!"

At those words, the constellations that had been arguing immediately fell silent.

Poseidon, who had been clutching the frozen pork belly, and Odin, who had been carving beside the stove, both stood up and walked somewhere.

The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, Jung Heewon, and I followed them.

The constellations gathered inside a small dining hall on one side of the factory. A middle-aged man standing in the center of the room was speaking energetically.

I asked,

"Who is that?"

"Um, he's the most recently captured one."

Strangely, unlike the other constellations, the middle-aged man wasn't wearing a leash.

"He's not a constellation. He's only here temporarily. I gave him a management role. He doesn't look like he'd try to run away, and he doesn't seem dangerous."

He's not a constellation, yet he came here from another worldline?

"All the constellations here seem to enjoy the stories he tells."

Judging by his expression, the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal also seemed to like the middle-aged man.

After briefly surveying the constellations, the middle-aged man spoke in a gentle voice.

"Yes, constellations. What kind of story would you like to hear today?"

Strangely, the middle-aged man's voice sounded familiar. The constellations gathered in the dining hall raised their hands like children and shouted.

"<Olympus>! I want to hear the myths of <Olympus>!"

"No, tell us a story from <Vedas>!"

"What an old-fashioned choice! As expected, <Asgard> is the best!"

Just as the room grew noisy again, Poseidon suddenly pulled out his recorder and slammed the table, saying,

"I want to hear that story you told me before again!"

At Poseidon's words, the constellations exchanged glances.

"If it's that story…"

"Well, I wouldn't mind hearing it again."

"What? What's it about?"

After calming the noisy room, the middle-aged man spoke again.

"Alright. Then today, I'll tell that story from last time again."

"Since some of you are hearing it for the first time, let's start from the beginning."

"Yes, I understand."

The middle-aged man cleared his throat and looked at the constellations with gentle eyes. Everyone was waiting eagerly for his story.

"This story."

And in the next moment, I realized who the middle-aged man was. His beard was thicker than I remembered, and his face was smeared with soup because he hadn't washed in a while, but it was still unmistakable. Because the story he had just begun—

"It's the story of the day I first met 'Kim Dokja' at Geumho Station."

It was a story I knew very well.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 991 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (12)

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"When I first met that guy, I definitely thought he was a villain. He had the look of a villain just by looking at him. You know, I mean. Those squinting eyes, that inscrutable expression, and even his slender build—"

It was the first time I had heard my story told in such detail by someone else.

"Those kinds of bad guys are everywhere!"

Several constellations shouted in indignation at the middle-aged man's tantalizing description. I, too, chuckled and nodded.

"And he was so good with words; whenever he opened his mouth, people would be completely blown away. He truly felt like a born swindler, a natural-born con artist, the ultimate swindler."

However, as I kept listening, I started to feel a little offended. Even a swindler gets annoyed when they keep hearing that they are a swindler.

As if he could read my mind, the middle-aged man continued speaking.

"But my daughter says that guys like that are actually quite popular."

["Right, strangely enough, those kinds of guys are popular! Damn it!"]

["Damn it, <Star Stream>!"]

I continued listening, feeling at a loss as to who to agree with.

"Anyway, he was an extraordinary friend from the start. While everyone else was out of their minds, he alone was fully alert and catching the bugs."

Perhaps it was due to the middle-aged man's masterful storytelling skills. The constellations reacted immediately.

["Bugs! That's a brilliant strategy!"]

["Did that method work in the first scenario?"]

["It must have worked for them to be alive, right?"]

Even the constellations, who had been skeptical at first, were soon engrossed in the story. I, the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, and Jung Heewon also joined the crowd to listen.

"So I said it out loud. Could you teach me how to catch bugs as well?"

As tension escalated, the constellations reacted.

["So? Did that guy tell you?"]

["Of course not! Humans wouldn't tell you that! They're a race too busy trying to survive on their own!"]

["It's obvious he's trying to monopolize the bugs—"]

The middle-aged man continued his story. The time they joined forces to catch the bugs, taught the people the strategy, and tried to survive the 'First Scenario' together.

["Humans wouldn't do such a thing! Don't lie!"]

Despite the reactions filled with disbelief, the middle-aged man continued speaking with a faint smile.

"But then, that cult leader bastard appeared!"

"A cult leader?"

Listening to the middle-aged man's story, I, too, recalled the events at 'Geumho Station'.

The appearance of the Life Cult Leader Kim Cheolyang. The debate over whether bacteria are living organisms or not. The birth of a cult. Meeting Lee Cheoldu, the boss of the Cheoldu faction. Even the change in the scenario completion conditions just before the scenario ended. The middle-aged man vividly described the battle that had taken place at Geumho Station with only ten minutes remaining.

And finally.

"Surprisingly, that friend protected me until the very end. And then the scenario time limit expired!"

The atmosphere in the dining hall fell solemn.

This was because none of the constellations here failed to understand what it meant for the scenario's time limit to have expired.

"Thanks to that friend, I am alive here right now."

The constellations who had been pointing fingers at the middle-aged man, claiming his story was a lie, as well as those who had been constantly nodding their heads or engaging in heated debates, remained silent for that moment.

Then someone asked.

["So, did that guy, that friend, end up dead?"]

Friend. I remember the person who had called me that for a long time. The person who had called me friend from the very beginning.

He was speaking.

"No, my friend did not die."

At that, the reactions of the constellations exploded.

["How did he survive? Didn't he fail to kill a single living creature?"]

["A watching constellation must have used a Deus Ex Machina for him!"]

["What nonsense! If he had done that in the first scenario—"]

Despite the boisterous reactions of the constellations, the middle-aged man simply smiled silently. He seemed accustomed to this scene.

It was then that Odin, who had remained silent the entire time, raised his hand. As the middle-aged man pointed at him, Odin asked.

["S-so, what is that friend of yours doing right now?"]

At the question, the middle-aged man's expression darkened for the first time. He hesitated for a while, then answered with a faint smile.

"He is alive."

Alive. A voice filled with faint but clear conviction.

"Surely, he must be alive somewhere."

Muttering this as if in prayer, the middle-aged man soon clapped lightly and brought order to the room.

"That is all for today's story. See you again at the next story reading. Now, let's eat!"

The distribution then began. The constellations lined up in turn to receive their rations. Today's menu was spicy stir-fried pork made with frozen pork belly.

"Oh, this is—"

"So this is frozen pork belly!"

I sat among them and ate with them. The vegetables and fruits grown in the smart farm were so fresh that I found myself wanting another bowl without even realizing it.

"Of course it's delicious. After all, Demeter harvested it herself."

As the Great Sage Heaven's Equal muttered, an old woman who had been eating silently in the distance looked over at me with an embarrassed expression.

'Demeter,' the ruler of agriculture and the seasons.

It seemed she, one of the Twelve Olympians, was also here.

With a dazed heart, I swallowed a strawberry and said,

"It's delicious."

A world where myth-grade constellations farm and cook their own meals. Did Kim Dokja really dream of a world like this? If so, what did he want to see at the end of this

world?

Just then, a middle-aged man who had just received his meal ration approached our table and sat down.

"Son-ssi, have you arrived?"

"Yes."

"Heewon-ssi, you've arrived too."

The man looked at Jung Heewon beside him, then glanced around again as if searching for someone else.

"Didn't Hyunsung-ssi come with you?"

"Yeah, he's a bit busy."

Busy. Is it really okay to describe it that simply? I thought of Lee Hyunsung, who must be struggling, surrounded by men in black suits right now. Suddenly, I wondered if it was okay for me to be eating something like this here.

"Excuse me."

It was then that Jung Heewon spoke. Ahjussi replied.

"Yes, please go ahead."

"Uh... no."

As if still not entirely certain, Jung Heewon glanced back at me. Then, ahjussi looked at me and asked.

"You seem to be eating well today, Dokja-ssi."

"Yes, because it's delicious."

"But I thought you usually couldn't eat tomatoes..."

Ahjussi looked down at my tray and spoke. I stared at him without answering. We looked other in silence for quite a while.

"Ah."

It was ahjussi who reacted first. His eyes slowly widened. The man, who had been looking at me with eyes full of distrust, opened his mouth in a trembling voice.

"Surely not..."

I had been thinking about reuniting with this person for a long time. What we would talk about when we met again, what expressions we would wear as we greeted each other. But when I actually met him, all the words I had thought of scattered, leaving only a single sentence lingering like a prayer.

"Just as much as you wished for me to be alive, I too wished for you to be alive."

Perhaps that is the story we truly wished for each other.

"Yes. I give."

He put down his chopsticks with trembling hands and looked at me.

He was the first person I met in this world, 'Kim Dokja: Jiyoon's father, and my old friend.'

"It's been a long time, Dansu ahjussi."

Amidst the bustling conversation of the rural constellations, I could see the tablecloth on his table getting wet.

I started eating again. Then, Dansu ahjussi picked up his chopsticks again and ate. We remained silent until we had finished our bowls.

It was a meal with Dansu ahjussi, whom I had met again after eight years.

"What? So, this ahjussi is the person you were looking for?"

After hearing Dansu ahjussi and my story, Great Sage Heaven's Equal stepped aside for a moment, and Jung Heewon also left to watch the constellations.

Dansu ahjussi and I sat in the reception room of the abandoned factory and shared a long conversation.

"Friend, how have you been?"

Holding Dansu ahjussi's hand tightly—which was still warm—I began to speak. Dansu ahjussi listened attentively to my words with the same calm eyes as before.

The time I parted ways with my companions and entered the Fear Realm. The time I left the Fear Realm and entered the 'New Murim District'. The journey from ascending 'Ragnarok' with Jung Heewon to finding the 'Missing Bush' on the stage of the preliminary battle.

"Ah..."

Listening to that journey, Dansu ahjussi sighed several times and shed tears several times. It seemed he had become more tearful since I last saw him.

"It seems you've been through a lot, too."

"Of course. I have been through a lot."

Dansu ahjussi hesitated for a moment before beginning his story. Some of it was a story I, too, knew from Kyung Sein.

The time my comrades scattered after I disappeared. Some left like Ji Eunyu, while others followed the 'New Kim Dokja'.

"If you mean the new Kim Dokja—"

"Yes. It is the 'Kim Dokja' who appeared after my friend disappeared."

Snowfield Kim Dokja. I was hearing the same story once again from Dansu ahjussi that I had also heard from Kyung Sein.

"Did you not stay with that Kim Dokja?"

"I was with him at first, too... but somehow, I ended up operating alone."

Dansu ahjussi continued his story, running his fingers across the table as if choosing his words.

"It wasn't because he was a bad person. He is genuinely worried about this world. He sincerely hoped that everyone could reach the end of the scenarios."

If Dansu ahjussi, of all people, felt that way, it couldn't be a lie.

"Then why did you come out separately?"

"It is a complicated matter to explain. Strangely, he didn't feel like 'Kim Dokja' to me."

Kim Dokja didn't feel like Kim Dokja. Hearing that from Dansu ahjussi, a fragment of Kim Dokja, made it sound like a very philosophical statement.

"It is difficult to explain, but that is the only way I can put it."

"In what way did you feel that way?"

"I felt that way when he left Sein-ssi behind in the 'New Murim District'."

Was that the reason after all?

Perhaps because that story came up, ahjussi, whose complexion had brightened for a moment, asked me.

"Come to think of it, my friend must have met Sein-ssi in the 'New Murim District'."

"Yes."

"Is Sein-ssi doing well?"

I deliberately avoided talking about Kyung Sein. However, seeing his condition, I felt I had to be honest.

I took the time to tell him about Kyung Sein's fate. How she fought to the very end, how she met the end of the story, and even where she is now.

"Ah..."

Ahjussi's eyes welled up with tears again.

"I really don't know why everything turned out this way."

I felt the same way. Nevertheless, the reason I couldn't give up on this story was that it was still going on. It was because that was still our life.

"There is one thing I want to ask you."

I recalled the pre-battle of 'Ragnarok' that ahjussi had participated in.

"I heard that there was a girl who went missing with you back then."

"Ah, that's right."

According to the records, Dansu ahjussi disappeared through the bushes of missing persons while trying to protect a girl to the very end. However, Dansu ahjussi was the only name I knew on the list of missing persons.

Dansu ahjussi slowly opened his mouth.

"That child is Shin Yoosung."

I was momentarily flustered by the unexpected name that came out of Dansu ahjussi's mouth.

"Yoosoung-i?"

That couldn't be right. If that were the case, Shin Yoosung would surely have been on the list of missing persons. But Shin Yoosung was neither on the list of missing persons nor on the list of survivors.

That meant—

"It wasn't the Yoosoung from this worldline."

"Ah."

It was only after hearing ahjussi's words that I realized how the situation had unfolded.

"If that child hadn't helped me, I probably would have died right there."

Shin Yoosung of <Kim Dokja Company>.

She had intervened in 'Ragnarok' in some way and led Dansu ahjussi to the bush of missing persons.

Perhaps because she wasn't a figure from this worldline, Shin Yoosung's information wasn't in the participant records for the 'Prelude'.

While I was happy that <Kim Dokja Company> had been safe until recently, I was also worried at the same time.

"Then, is Yoosoung-i here in this world by any chance?"

But if Shin Yoosung had come here, why hadn't the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and Lee Hyunsung mentioned it?

"Ahjussi."

Dansu ahjussi had clearly said he entered with the girl Shin Yoosung was possessing. But no matter how I looked at it, Dansu ahjussi was here alone right now.

A sudden ominous premonition struck.

"What happened to Yoosoung-i...?"

---

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 992 Episode 59 What Kind of Ending (13)

Dansu ahjussi remained silent for a moment. His gaze seemed to recall a distant memory, yearn for it, and feel sorrow.

"I don't know what happened to Miss Yoosoung either."

Dansu ahjussi's expression was filled with guilt as he said this.

"Actually, when I jumped into the bushes, I was barely unconscious."

That was understandable. Dansu ahjussi's team had suffered a near-total annihilation in the preliminary battle.

Even amidst that, Dansu ahjussi would not have given up until the very end to save a single child. He would have searched through the bushes to help even a single survivor escape.

Perhaps Shin Yoosung of <Kim Dokja Company> watched Dansu ahjussi like that, and eventually, unable to bear it any longer, used her power.

"The aftershock of probability swept in, and my body was crumbling."

I recalled how Kim Anna and Kim Namwoon had faced the aftermath of probability.

Perhaps ahjussi had also been in a similar crisis.

"If it weren't for Miss Yoosoung, I would have died there."

Shin Yoosung likely used 'The Beast Lord's Sensitivity' to align with ahjussi, taking on the burden of probability that Dansu ahjussi was supposed to bear.

"But the moment Miss Yoosoung protected me, my body began to be dragged somewhere."

He, too, seemed to understand what kind of phenomenon it was. This was because I, too, had experienced something similar.

"It is difficult to explain, but it felt like a very distant primordial energy was calling me. Unconsciously, I followed that energy and flowed, eventually arriving here."

"Then, Yoosoung-i—"

"We parted ways the moment we entered this place."

I sighed. Even if it was Shin Yoosung of <Kim Dokja Company>, and even though this scenario was in its later stages, I couldn't tell if it was acceptable to abuse such power.

"Have you not met Yoosoung since then?"

"Unfortunately..."

From what I heard, it had been about two years since Dansu ahjussi entered this place.

And during those two years, he had been constantly searching for news of Shin Yoosung.

"Perhaps because we fell into this world together. And above all, what Miss Yoosoung said to me right before entering the world weighed on my mind."

"What did she say?"

Dansu ahjussi pondered deeply once again, his expression as if searching for a memory, before finally uttering a single word.

"The big house."

"The big house?"

I know what that word means to Shin Yoosung of <Kim Dokja Company>. Dansu ahjussi continued.

"I don't know why, but the moment I heard those words, I somehow became convinced that Miss Yoosoung was also entering the same world as me."

I nodded and asked.

"Did you happen to tell this story to the Great Sage Heaven's Equal as well?"

"I did speak to him, but..."

Just as Asmodeus and other myth-grade constellations did, if Shin Yoosung had entered this worldline, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal would surely have noticed.

However, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal did not seem to give any particular indication.

There was a possibility that something had happened to Shin Yoosung upon entering this worldline. If she had entered this world, she would have come looking for the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, Lee Hyunsung, or Jung Heewon long ago. The fact that there was still no contact...

Buzz.

The smartphone vibrated. As I checked the call with a light spark, a familiar modifier appeared in the center of the screen.

—Demon King of Salvation.

It was my eldest brother.

---

I excused myself from Dansu ahjussi and stepped out of the reception room to answer the phone. I could feel several constellations glancing at me as they passed by, but right now, I had no energy to pay attention to such things individually.

"Just how long has it been since you last contacted me?"

I wondered just how long it had been since the last call. I struggled to suppress my joy and urged him on.

"Yes? If you have a mouth, say something?"

He probably doesn't know. How much I missed him.

As if puzzled by my reaction, a snorting voice came from the other end of the line.

—Are you really that happy to see me? I'm stuck in your library anyway. It's practically the same as always being together.

"What's the point of being together? We can't even have a conversation."

—Have you been doing well?

Just hearing his voice made me feel strange.

「The only being in this world who can accurately understand my emotions.」

I don't know if that's the right way to put it, but the feeling I get when I think of the first was similar to that.

"What if I haven't been doing well?"

—You have to be doing well. We all live our lives struggling to get along."

Hearing that from the first made me feel strange all over again.

Perhaps having entered a world where scenarios don't exist has simply increased my own sense of sentimentality.

—Did you meet the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal?

"I met him."

The eldest replied immediately, as if he roughly understood the situation.

—I've been in contact with Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal quite often."

"Is that so?"

—Yeah, it seems outsiders keep appearing in that area. Oh, by the way, did you meet the third one?"

I don't know if I should say we met, or if we didn't.

I simply conveyed the situation I was in.

That I am currently possessing the third one's body, that Asmodeus had appeared, that the third one's soul had vanished somewhere, and that men in black suits had appeared chasing us.

—Asmodeus...

Upon hearing my explanation, the eldest's voice was quite displeased.

It was a tone filled with conviction that this story couldn't possibly end merely at the 'Asmodeus' stage.

I then shared the information I had heard from Dansu ahjussi.

—You said Shin Yoosung seems to be in that timeline?

"Maybe."

Leaving aside why Shin Yoosung hadn't appeared before us yet, if she really was in this timeline, it was somewhat of a comfort to me.

If I could just meet Shin Yoosung, she would be a tremendous asset in our current situation.

However, the eldest seemed to have a different opinion.

—That’s bad news.

"Huh? Why?"

—Who from <Kim Dokja Company> is there right now?

"The Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal and—"

—Except for the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal. Strictly speaking, he isn't <Kim Dokja Company>.

"Lee Hyunsung-ssi and Jung Heewon-ssi. Jung Heewon-ssi is currently possessed by the 41st iteration, so it's a bit ambiguous—"

—And you too. Then there are already four members of <Kim Dokja Company> in the same timeline.

Come to think of it, it had been a really long time since so many members of <Kim Dokja Company> had gathered together.

"So?"

—Don't you understand what I mean?

In an instant, something flashed through my mind.

—Do you think it is normal for you to be that happy to see me?

I flinched and reflected on my own emotions. The first was right. No matter how happy I was to see the first, it was rare for me to express my emotions to this extent.

It was clear what was influencing my current state.

"Is the story of <Kim Dokja Company> growing stronger?"

As the figures forming the core of the giant story gathered, the story began to influence the members of the world.

—Because that world was originally created for that purpose. The third is dreaming of that world.

This world is a kind of 'big house' that Kim Dokja created for <Kim Dokja Company>. Kim Dokja must have hoped that <Kim Dokja Company> would gather here and find some small comfort.

However, due to the choices made by <Kim Dokja Company>, the world's dream remained unrealized for a long time.

—If the story’s gravitational pull continues to grow stronger, the story will naturally summon the elements necessary to realize itself.

However, in the midst of this, Dansu ahjussi—a fragment of Kim Dokja—and I were dragged into this world, and even Shin Yoosung entered this timeline. The elements for the story’s realization were beginning to take shape one by one.

"I suppose other <Kim Dokja Company> members might come here as well."

Honestly, I thought it would be better for <Kim Dokja Company> to come to this world rather than just the others.

But once again, the first seemed to have a different perspective.

—If it is certain that the third was kidnapped, that world is currently in a very unstable state. If another <Kim Dokja Company> member were to appear in that state, the world itself could collapse due to the oversaturated story.

I hadn't even considered that possibility.

"Then what should we do?"

—We have to escape immediately. We met Dansu ahjussi, didn't we? If we stay there, even you would get caught up in it and perish.

"Then what about the third?"

—If he has fallen into their hands anyway, it will be hard to save him.

"Are you serious?"

I never expected the 'Demon King of Salvation', of all people, to say something like that.

I spoke in a somewhat disappointed tone.

"You never know until you try, do you? We could rescue him."

—Rescue him? How? You know what kind of world that is.

"…"

—You aren't actually trusting the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal, are you? That guy can't really use his power there. He's just a slightly stronger monkey.

"We have capable forces here besides the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal. There's Heewon-ssi, and there's Hyunsung-ssi."

—Even with those two, it won't work. They are just ordinary people there.

"Besides, there are myth-grade constellations."

—Myth-grade constellations?

"As for who is here—"

—Wait a minute. You mean Poseidon and Odin, you mean them?

"The way you put it, it sounds like you're calling out the names of neighborhood guys."

It seemed the first had already grasped the ecosystem of this place.

—Do you really think those guys will be of any help?

Just then, I saw Poseidon passing by in the distance, hitting Odin on the head with a recorder.

I tried to ignore the scene and spoke.

"They may look like that, but they are myth-grade constellations."

—But you are myth-grade too.

"No, I am different. Still, they are orthodox, and I—"

—Don't even think about borrowing their hands. Do you think they would help in the first place? You haven't forgotten what kind of bastards they are, have you? Just take the people and escape quickly. That is the only solution. As long as <Kim Dokja Company>, which is different from you, isn't in that world, the story won't manifest anyway.

It was a valid argument, but there was one major flaw in the plan.

"No. I promised the Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal. That he would save the third with me."

—What nonsense are you talking about… You just…!

With a spark, the call was cut off. It seems the connection is dead again. I was happy when I answered the phone, but once we actually talked, my mind became a mess.

"Dokja-ssi."

I don't know when she approached, but Jung Heewon was standing behind me. She looked at me with a somewhat worried expression, then gestured somewhere with her chin. Judging by her expression, it seemed something wrong had happened.

"I think you need to come over here for a moment."

---

Jung Heewon and I returned to the usual restaurant district. The constellations, including Great Sage Heaven's Equal and Dansu ahjussi, were already gathered there, watching the news on the old television set up in the center.

—In response, the government issued a statement regarding 'terrorists'...

It was a continuation of the news we had just seen. The eyes of the constellations widened one by one as they saw Great Sage Heaven's Equal's face filling the screen.

"What is that?"

"Why is that monkey bastard appearing?"

Just as I was wondering if it was okay to show him like that, Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who was watching the news beside me, muttered.

"Damn it, it looks so much worse than I am in real life."

"Is this really the time to be saying such idle things?"

"Believe it or not, I used to be an idol."

Come to think of it, this primate had debuted as an idol alongside the Black Flame Dragon and Uriel in the 1,864th round. I suddenly thought about asking about those days, but the news that followed left me speechless.

—It is reported that the government has already secured one of the terrorists…

On the screen, Lee Hyunsung was being broadcast, tied to a chair.

Perhaps finding it difficult to crack a joke this time, even Great Sage, Heaven’s Equal wore a rather serious expression.

"That bastard Hyunsung. Is he already caught?"

"It looks really dangerous."

Just as I was wondering what would happen if Lee Hyunsung died like that, Great Sage Heaven's Equal shook his head and said.

"He won't die. That guy is sturdier than me. Did you forget his nickname?"

"You don't actually think Hyunsung-ssi is made of steel, do you?"

"Yeah, well, I have to go rescue him. That's why I came. I have to find the youngest anyway."

Great Sage Heaven's Equal let out a light sigh, glanced at the constellations in the dining hall, and clapped his hands loudly.

"Alright, you gluttons! Pay attention!"

At his thunderous roar, the constellations gathered in the dining area turned toward him in unison. As if satisfied with their reaction, Great Sage Heaven's Equal began to speak.

"The time has come for you to repay my kindness! You need to help me out!"

It was an attitude of sheer shamelessness. However, perhaps accustomed to such behavior, the constellations asked readily instead of getting angry.

"What do you want me to help you with?"

"Yeah. You know Hyunsung, right? Our second. The good friend who always comes to feed you guys."

At the mention of food, several constellations turned to each other and muttered.

"You mean that bear-like guy?"

"He is a good guy."

Fortunately, it seemed that Lee Hyunsung had made a good impression on the constellations in the past. Seeing that the reaction from the crowd was not negative, Great Sage Heaven's Equal got straight to the point, as if he had nothing left to weigh.

"Right, it looks like that guy has been captured by some bad guys. Let's go rescue him together."

"Why are you asking us? Couldn't you go alone?"

"They have quite a few more people than I can rescue him by myself."

With everyone having eaten frozen pork belly, Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke with a look of certainty that there would be volunteers.

"Alright, who wants to go rescue Hyunsung with me? Raise your hand!"

However, the constellations merely exchanged wary glances, and no one raised their hand. Just as Great Sage Heaven's Equal, frowning, was about to speak again, someone among the constellations burst into loud laughter.

"Hahahahahahaha!"

Following this, a wave of snickers spread among the constellations in the restaurant district. Poseidon, who had been observing the situation from a corner, spoke up.

"Serves you right, you monkey bastard! You are finally in danger!"

"…"

"What? Help us? You locked us up here, and now you're saying you need help and want to borrow the hands of old geezers?"

Judging by the way things were going, it seemed the situation was unfolding just as the first had predicted. Perhaps it was an inevitable outcome.

There was no way those 'constellations of the Great Nebulae' would help us.

"You deserve divine punishment! Who do you think you're asking for help from right now!"

"That's right! After turning us into powerless old geezers..."

"No, that's because you guys failed the possession—"

It seemed the more the Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke, the worse the situation became, so I felt I should step in at this point.

"It doesn't seem like there is any particular reason for us to help you."

However, someone spoke before me.

When I turned to look at where the voice came from, an old man wearing a fluorescent safety vest and work gloves was standing there. He walked past me with a bored expression and exchanged brief greetings with the other constellations.

One of the Constellations asked him.

"What? Where have you been? Something interesting just happened."

"The power went out at the smart farm, so I went and fixed it. I heard the gist of it."

"Oh, did you finally fix it?"

It appeared the old man was working on the power facilities here.

Wait a minute, power facilities?

"Was that constellation here too?"

"Hmm, didn't I mention it?"

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal replied in a somewhat indifferent voice.

"Things got a bit messed up. I was planning to accept applicants before that guy arrived."

Judging by the situation, that old electrician seemed to be a constellation with quite a bit of recognition in this area.

As if he fully understood how things were going, the old electrician neatly removed his work gloves, placed them on the table, wiped his sweat, and sat down on a chair. Then, he muttered to himself.

"If a force threatening you has appeared in this timeline, it's obvious who it is."

The old electrician turned his head and looked out through the iron bars at the abandoned factory.

Just then, the sound of rain falling outside could be heard. Faint thunder echoed in the distance. Watching the old man’s piercing eyes stare at the lightning, I recalled his name anew.

"Finally, the children of <Olympus> have come to save me."

The leader of <Olympus>—the Throne of Lightning, Zeus.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 993 Episode 60 Star Fragments (1)

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「Only those with the courage to go missing in this world can glimpse the truth of the stories.」

—The Evil Sophist.

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At Zeus's words, several constellations stirred here and there.

["That's right! <Olympus> could not possibly forget us!"]

Not everyone had lost hope just because they were trapped in this world. While some, like Odin, dismissed the <Star Stream> as a delusion, and others, like Poseidon, had adapted in their own ways, there were stars who still could not forget their former stature.

["Then <Veda> might come, too."]

["No, perhaps <Asgard> will come first!"]

I looked at the culprit who had orchestrated this entire situation.

Zeus, leaning against a table with a relaxed smile, was looking at me with a somewhat triumphant expression.

To think that even 'Zeus' himself would be trapped here.

Come to think of it, there was no way the gentleman obsessed with 'collecting Kim Dokja fragments' the other day would miss this feast.

["Release us quickly! You damned monkey!"]

Several excited constellations approached the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and caused a ruckus. I was worried an accident might occur, but unexpectedly, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal remained calm.

"What are you going to do if I let you go?"

["What?"]

"Do you really think your Nebula will come to rescue you? Why would they bother with losers like you?"

["What nonsense! We are myth-grade constellations!"]

The thunder echoing from outside grew even louder.

Even though [Incite] is my specialty, this was not a situation where I should get involved. Besides, there was already someone here better suited to rallying the stars than I was.

"Dansu ahjussi."

Dansu ahjussi, who had been sitting beside me with a pale face, nodded and approached.

I remembered the man named Lee Dansu well. He was an incarnation living in this world to save his daughter—a father who had steadfastly built his history to face his daughter with dignity.

「The only one among the fragments of Kim Dokja to inherit Kim Dokja's trait, the 'Immortal King'.」

The constellations must have recognized Dansu ahjussi's character as well. After all, the legend of a good person is bound to show through.

"I need help."

I thought Dansu ahjussi would understand immediately, but his reaction was unexpectedly lukewarm.

"What kind of help do you need, my friend?"

"I mean the constellations."

While the Great Sage Heaven's Equal held off the crowd, I briefly whispered the plan to Dansu ahjussi. Fortunately, he grasped it quickly.

"The stratagem of 'borrowing a sword to kill'… Are you suggesting we rally the constellations to stop the intruders?"

"Yes. I thought they would listen to you better than me. The constellations seem to follow you."

At this, Dansu ahjussi replied with a bitter smile.

"I was just telling them a story about the past with my friend."

I heard it too. Even after so much time had passed, he still cherished his memories of me. It is rare to find someone who keeps another's story so preciously. Dansu ahjussi was such a rare and good person.

"Then please make use of that story."

And I must make such a good person do something a little bad.

"Please persuade the constellations to help us. You can set a plausible bait. Like, if they help us, we will let them escape this worldline—"

"Are you really going to do that to the constellations, my friend?"

I was speechless for a moment. Ahjussi's gaze was serious, but this was not a matter I could compromise on.

"Even if you can't do it, you must say that you can right now."

I know ahjussi is a good person, but those standing there now were 'constellations'.

"Hyunsung-ssi is in danger. We cannot save him with our strength alone."

I know those constellations might not be much help. Since they were all captured by the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, most of them must have had their powers sealed. Still, we were in a desperate situation where every hand counted.

"They cannot fight. To be precise, they are not in a state to fight."

For a moment, I couldn't understand why this old man was protecting these constellations to such an extent.

"That doesn't matter."

Those words slipped out before I realized it. Was this feeling mine, or the Third's—or perhaps the nameless Kim Dokja's?

「I hate stars.」

Perhaps this is an old, deep-seated emotion of Kim Dokja's.

["You monkey bastard! If you don't let us go right now, I'll—"]

I glanced at the constellations once more. From the marine Poseidon to the master sculptor Odin, and even the electrician Zeus. That scene, resembling a nursing home for retired elders, was somehow delightful and comical.

But that was as far as it went.

「They are myth-grade constellations who have always watched us—those who reveled in the tragedies of this world.」

I remembered clearly what they had done in the scenarios and the Fear Realm. I remembered everything they had done to the people I loved.

Nevertheless, Dansu ahjussi shook his head.

"My friend, you still don't know."

Dansu ahjussi gazed at me with sorrowful eyes.

"Those stars..."

The moment I heard his voice, I felt a sense of unease.

「Why have these constellations gathered in a place like this?」

At first, I thought they were merely stars gathered to claim the 'third Kim Dokja', just as they had sought the 'Oldest Dream' to control the 41st worldline.

「But the constellations here were those 'myth-grade constellations'.」

The pinnacle of the <Star Stream>—the stars of the 'Round Table' that rule over everything.

Mitra's voice wavered in my mind.

[Didn't you know? That I am a coward.]

Did the stars of the Round Table, more cautious and cunning than any other, really risk their lives to enter this worldline solely because 'the third Kim Dokja' was here?

Thump.

A deafening roar echoed from the front of the abandoned factory.

Headlights flashed outside the window.

Poseidon muttered.

"They have arrived."

Several constellations pushed aside the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and ran toward the entrance.

As expected, Zeus was the first.

"My children have come."

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, Dansu ahjussi, and Jung Heewon exchanged glances and followed. As I approached the entrance, a sense of foreboding grew. An unprecedented energy was gathering in this world where stories could not exert their power.

「Perhaps the constellations were right after all.」

The constellations combined their strength to force open the factory gates. Soon, amidst the bright beams of headlights, men in black suits appeared.

["Oh! Come in! Over here! Quickly!"]

The men in suits looked surprised to see the constellations welcoming them.

"What are these people?"

The men in suits stopped, wary of the situation. A muscular man in sunglasses at the front restrained his subordinates as if sensing something unsettling.

"Wait."

The moment I heard his voice, I instinctively sensed it.

「He is no ordinary person.」

Just like the constellations here, 'something' was possessing the man in the suit.

"Well done, you managed to make it this far."

As if recognizing him, Zeus approached with open arms.

As he stepped out of the gate, sparks flew from the leash Zeus shared with the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, but the God of Thunder endured the pain and kept walking.

As Zeus stopped in front of him, the man in the suit flinched.

"No way?"

Removing his sunglasses, the man widened his eyes.

I had never seen him before, but strangely, I felt I knew who he was. The shimmering stories of <Olympus> provided the record.

「He is the 'Monster Slayer'. The Greek hero who had never properly appeared in the main story.」

Zeus took him by the shoulder, welcoming him.

"My son! Perseus!"

Perseus. The legendary hero who defeated Medusa was standing before me.

Perseus’s expression changed as he recognized Zeus.

"Father? You were really here?"

"Yes, my son."

"To think the rumors were true... It is an honor to meet you."

As a smile spread across Perseus’s lips, Zeus’s complexion brightened. He turned toward the constellations and shouted.

"Come out, all constellations. My son has come to take us."

The constellations poked their heads out one by one. As if asking why they were so frightened, Zeus shouted.

"The time we have been waiting for has come. It is time for us all to escape this damn worldline together—"

The moment he spoke, a stream of blood shot into the air. The smell of copper spread through the drizzle. As the stars held their breath, Zeus turned with a look of foolish confusion. There stood Perseus, still smiling.

"Father."

Perseus struck Zeus's arm once again with a thick machete.

"It is truly an honor to be able to kill you."

With a whoosh, one of Zeus's arms flew into the air.

Zeus, eyes wide, screamed as he watched the blood gushing from his shoulder.

"Aaaargh—!"

It was an unbelievably weak scream for a myth-grade constellation.

Perseus, looking at Zeus with curiosity, turned toward the constellations with a cold gaze.

"It was true that the myth-grade constellations are all trapped here."

Perseus was not alone. The men in suits behind him glared with menacing intensity.

Perseus let out a booming voice.

"The opportunity to achieve the impossible has arrived."

A strange desire blazed in his voice.

"If we successfully complete the mission of this worldline, we will leap into the realm of myth that we have so long awaited!"

The men in suits began to approach. The myth-grade constellations, trembling helplessly, slumped to the ground. It was the Great Sage Heaven's Equal who lifted them up.

"What are you doing, you fools!"

Snatched by the nape of the neck, Zeus was pulled back into the factory by the Great Sage.

"Everyone, go inside! Close the gate! Do you all want to die?"

The constellations followed in a panic.

Several men in suits rushed to open the door, but they were sent flying by the Great Sage's kicks.

The factory door slammed shut, and the shouts of the men in suits echoed from outside.

"Hiding is useless! You cowardly constellations!"

"Hahahaha! Serves you right!"

The myth-grade constellations trembled at the mocking laughter.

It was a strange sight.

I knew many constellations aspired to 'myth' status, but to kill the 'myth-grade constellations' of their own nebula?

It should have been impossible. No matter how blinded by status, a star could not easily turn its back on its elders.

The history they lived had imposed a taboo.

「All constellations of the Great Nebula move in the direction of amplifying the Great Nebula's Giant Story.」

If they annihilated Zeus and the others, the power of the nebula would weaken despite their individual rise.

This meant they had a justification that went beyond the restraining force of that 'Giant Story'.

"I told you, friend."

Dansu ahjussi spoke as he approached. His calm eyes were fixed on the constellations.

"Now, my friend will be able to see them too."

I gazed at the constellations—stars abandoned by the nebulae. The old men were trembling, clutching their narrow shoulders.

"…Yes."

Grains of stories drifted unsteadily over Zeus's wound. Only then did it make sense.

The reason these 'myth-grade constellations' were so helpless. The reason they were old men, easily subdued and imprisoned.

「Did those 'myth-grade constellations' really stake everything on jumping into this worldline?」

I spoke, gazing at the shadowless elders.

"So, all the 'myth-grade constellations' here were their 'fragments'."

It was natural. The true 'myth-grade constellations' ruling the Round Table would never risk their own lives directly.

["Ahhhh! Have you finally betrayed us!"]

["I will not forgive you! Damn it, you children!"]

These old men were merely 'fragments' chosen by the constellations—clones deployed on the most dangerous missions. Beings sacrificed without consequence in a world where one wrong move meant death. In other words, they were—

「Fragments that the myth-grade constellations judged to be 'okay to disappear'.」

The abandoned fragments of the stars were howling in the light right before my eyes.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 994 Episode 60 Star Fragments (2)

"We're going to die. We're all going to die!"

The terrified constellations were flopping about like fish. Star fragments from which it was impossible to tell just how damaged the original form of the story was, or whose fragments they were.

"You bastard! This is all your fault!"

"You damned Zeus!"

"I shouldn't have listened to him!"

The constellations, who had been excited by Zeus's instigation, were now busy cursing him.

Zeus, slumped over, remained silent, appearing to have suffered a great shock.

Blood was still dripping from his right arm, which the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had hastily bound. It was a wound where an average old man would have already died from excessive bleeding. Yet, the fact that he was still alive—was it because he was, after all, a fragment of Zeus?

"This way! Let's bolt this side!"

Dansu ahjussi and the constellations dragged in the broken machinery and firmly sealed off the entrance to the abandoned factory. The constellations gasped for breath and wiped their sweat.

"They won't be able to get in with this, right?"

Of course, such measures were unlikely to ensure safety. However, the myth-grade constellations, having been imprisoned for so long, seemed to have lost some of their basic judgment.

Whoosh.

A pungent smell wafted from somewhere, and soon smoke began to roll in from the front of the abandoned factory. The surrounding temperature was rising.

"No, they set it on fire!"

The terrified constellations cried out.

Looking hurriedly beyond the bars, the front of the factory grounds was already engulfed in flames.

"Burn it harder! Burn them all to death!"

At this rate, they were doomed to burn to death along with the abandoned factory. Flames were already spreading inside the factory, and loud explosions, both large and small, could be heard from all directions.

"Come this way!"

Dansu ahjussi and the Great Sage Heaven's Equal hurriedly evacuated the constellations to the back. Just as I, too, was about to pull away with Jung Heewon, the figures of Poseidon and Zeus appeared through the flames.

"Get up quickly, Zeus."

Poseidon reached out his hand toward Zeus, who was still slumped in his seat.

"It's not over yet. Have you forgotten who you are? The Great Throne of Lightning, the strongest god of <Olympus>—"

"You're wrong!"

But Zeus's eyes already showed a loss of will.

"This is the end for us all. We're going to die here."

With a crashing sound from somewhere, the ceiling began to collapse. The steel structure slammed onto the floor, trapping Zeus's leg under part of it.

Zeus looked up at Poseidon without a hint of pain, then closed his eyes in resignation.

"You fool."

In the end, even Poseidon gave up on Zeus. Immediately, shouts from the constellations echoed from all directions.

"The smart farm is on fire!"

"Recover the crops!"

"No, there are still guys who haven't managed to escape!"

A terrified Poseidon ran toward the smart farm, shouting.

"Demeter! Demeter! Where are you!"

Demeter, the guardian of agriculture and the seasons and the caretaker of the smart farm, was the wife of Poseidon.

I glanced at Jung Heewon.

"Heewon-ssi."

Jung Heewon hesitated for a moment, then nodded in response.

"Understood."

Jung Heewon ran straight toward the smart farm.

"Everyone, take cover this way!"

The stinging smoke was growing thicker and thicker. There were hardly any constellations left in the vicinity. If the flames grew just a little larger here, I, too, would be in danger. I had to make a choice.

I stared at the steel structure on the collapsed floor for a moment, then grabbed a cutting stick from nearby and inserted it between the structures like a lever. With a click, I applied force, and the structure began to move slightly.

The scorching heat scratched my cheeks, and the pain was excruciating as if my soles had been burned, but I did not give up.

How long had I been applying that force? With the sound of metal sliding, the structure twisted. Following that, the half-baked face of Zeus was revealed amidst the debris.

Zeus, spotting me, opened his mouth in surprise.

"What... are you doing?"

"Stay still."

I dug through the wreckage and dragged Zeus's body out. Zeus, now an old electrician, was light enough for me—with my terrible strength—to support him.

Carried on my back, Zeus struggled slightly and said,

"I don't need any help..."

"Shut up."

I started running, carrying Zeus, who was left with only one arm.

I couldn't understand myself either. Why had I saved Zeus?

「He was the star that destroyed my world.」

<Kim Dokja Company> and my comrades were struck by his fleet. The incarnations of the Fear Realm lost their lives. In this iteration, and in other iterations, he was always my greatest nemesis.

「The star that guarded the ark heading to the end of the world.」

I saw the doors of the restaurant district closing in the distance.

"Don't close them yet! Open the restaurant! Hurry!"

Fortunately, a constellation spotted us. It was Odin.

Odin, who was still carving sculptures, looked at me and Zeus with a blank expression; then, as if having made a decision, he put down his carving knife and grabbed the dining room door.

I entered the dining room with Zeus by a hair's breadth. With a thud, the door slammed shut, and I dropped Zeus onto the floor as if tossing him down.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal looked at me with wide eyes.

"What? When did you rescue this guy?"

Zeus glared at me, panting heavily. Dansu ahjussi, who had rushed over, briefly checked on Zeus's condition before approaching me and asking.

"Friend, are you alright?"

I looked up for a moment at Dansu ahjussi as he extended his hand, then took it and stood up. As if turning a blind eye to the subtle emotion in his eyes, I opened my mouth.

"I do not agree with your method, ahjussi."

I know why Dansu ahjussi sympathizes with the stars. We, fragments of Kim Dokja, are like the stars. I understand the feelings one cannot help but have toward these fragments of the constellations.

"It is simply to use these guys."

Dansu ahjussi is certainly right. The tragedy of this world originates from scenarios and is dominated by stories.

One cannot hate every star, nor can one love every star. In the end, even Kim Dokja could not do so. Nevertheless, we might be able to embrace all this tragedy. And thus, we might be able to contemplate the act of forgiving someone.

Of course, doing so would not make this world run its course properly, but at least through that, I would be able to understand why Dansu ahjussi is making that expression.

So, Dansu ahjussi is just—

"That is why I like my friend."

He must be trying to speak of a possible ending.

We looked at each other and smiled bitterly. Even though we had been apart for eight years, he and I were still each other's friends.

"When did I ever ask you to save me?"

Zeus, who had been glaring at us with piercing eyes, screamed in a fit of rage.

"Your help is of the essence—"

"You're really going to end it here... Is that it?"

"What?"

"You wouldn't give up over something as trivial as this."

Watching Zeus get agitated, I actually became calmer.

I imagined the 'constellation of Lightning' I knew.

"I remember clearly just how terrifying an enemy Zeus was. The constellation of Lightning in <Olympus> that I know isn't this quick to give up. It is a constellation that is endlessly persistent and cunning."

"What do you know about me—"

"You are a truly vicious and terrible star."

The constellation of Lightning, 'Zeus,' survived until the very end of the scenario in every worldline. He held Yoo Joonghyuk back time and time again and tormented <Kim Dokja Company>. I, too, nearly died at his hands several times.

"Are you going to die here at the hands of a mere guy like Perseus? Are you going to end your life with such a conclusion?"

I don't know how to persuade the stars. I didn't want to persuade them in the first place. I simply need their strength, so I just offer words to lift them up.

I turned to look at the constellations staring at me with agitated faces.

"You are the same. Do you really want to give up on ■■ right here?"

■■. The end of all stories.

I could feel a faint flame flickering in the eyes of the myth-grade constellations.

"But what can we do right now?"

It was Poseidon who spoke those words. Poseidon, his face smeared with soot from supporting Demeter, added in a dark voice.

"You should know, seeing this state."

Even while being humiliated by a mere Perseus, the eyes of the myth-grade constellations remained nothing but resentful.

"We haven't even fought properly yet."

At that, Zeus interrupted once again.

"There are things you can know without fighting."

"You managed to rise to myth-grade with that kind of will."

"You managed to reach myth-grade? You, who haven't even set foot on a shadow of a mythical being, dare to mention 'myth'?"

I pouted and retorted.

"I am myth-grade, too."

"You? Don't lie!"

Just then, Odin, who had been silently sculpting something in the corner, suddenly lifted his head and spoke.

"What he said is true!"

"What?"

"I know."

Odin bowed his head low again and began sculpting. What on earth is he sculpting so diligently in a situation like this? Is he trying to create the final masterpiece of his life?

In any case, at Odin's remark, Zeus glared at me once more and scrutinized me from head to toe.

"So what? Even if you are myth-grade like us, aren't you just as trapped in that body as we are? Being trapped in a small prison and unable to do anything—"

"Is there nothing you can do when you're locked up?"

"What?"

"To 'Zeus' outside who threw you into a place like this—"

I looked at the thumping dining room door.

"Don't you want to show who the 'real one' is?"

With a crunching sound, the door began to crumble little by little. The enemies had already started pushing their way inside.

"I'm abandoning this place and escaping."

Making a quick decision, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal tore off the iron bars near the dining room ceiling, threw himself out, and spoke.

"Hold on just a little longer. I'll be back soon."

The constellations swarmed through the bars from which the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had escaped, screaming to somehow pull themselves out.

"D-Don't push!"

"Aaaargh! I can't get out! I said I can't get out!"

However, for their aging bodies, even grabbing onto the broken bars and climbing up was a struggle.

"Everyone, stay calm! The Great Sage Heaven's Equal will be back to rescue you soon! We can all escape together!"

Despite Dansu ahjussi's encouragement, the constellations were not easily calmed.

"Don't make me laugh! That guy ran away alone!"

"We're all going to die! We're all going to die right here!"

This was their true nature. They had entered this place as myth-grade constellations, but all they possessed were trash stories thrown away by their true forms.

Unnecessary greed and arrogance, wariness, weakness and fear…

All kinds of stories of defeat, which myth-grade constellations regard as a disgrace, were seething together like a blazing inferno.

「Are all these stories truly useless?」

I thought and thought about the constellations of the Round Table who would have cast those stories aside without hesitation.

Crunch!

Finally, the door broke down, and men in black suits appeared. As the men boldly entered the dining area, swinging their batons and machetes, Jung Heewon stepped forward as if she had been waiting.

"I'll stop them."

Displaying unbelievable superhuman strength, Jung Heewon began to take on the men in suits at the entrance all by herself.

"Argh!"

"What is this woman—"

The men screamed and collapsed at the dazzling trajectory of her wooden sword.

Astonished by Jung Heewon's fierce performance, the constellations widened their eyes.

"How—"

I was just as surprised. Even if we excused it since the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was a monster to begin with, Jung Heewon's performance right now was truly on a level comparable to that of the Great Sage.

"Break through! Quick!"

"There's a gap!"

However, even Jung Heewon began to miss her enemies one by one. The men in suits, having finally entered the restaurant, rushed toward the constellations.

Unluckily, the first to be targeted was me, who had been loitering near the entrance. A man in a suit swung a machete menacingly, and as I stepped back, I ended up landing on my butt. The blade of the machete fell on my head.

"Friend!"

Dansu ahjussi rushed over in an instant, pushed me aside, and took the machete blade instead. Watching the blood splatter unrealistically into the air, I reflexively threw myself forward and pushed the man with the machete with all my might. The man tumbled to the ground with a scream. I plunged the fallen machete into his chest with both hands. Vivid blood gushed out, and soon the man breathed his last. Gasping for breath, I turned around. Dansu ahjussi lay there, his chest slashed.

「There is no system in this world.」

I hurriedly lifted the bleeding Dansu ahjussi to his feet.

「Neither the Spirit of the Elaine Forest nor the Great Elixir can be used.」

Fortunately, the wound wasn't deep. However, it was a dangerous injury that needed immediate treatment.

「If you die here, you really will die.」

Now, it was truly no longer a situation where I could worry about the constellations.

I supported Dansu ahjussi and looked around. I had to find a place to hide. Anywhere—

"Kill them!"

But the number of men in suits surging in was too great. A telescopic baton flew from somewhere and struck my thigh. As my knee buckled from the impact, the baton flew straight toward my head. An unavoidable blow. Biting my lip tightly, I raised my arm to protect my head. Sparks flew right before my eyes. Shards of plastic shattered. A broken recorder spout rolled across the floor.

With a dazed expression, I stared at the back of the head of the old man who had saved me. Clutching the broken recorder tightly, Poseidon was blocking the way.

"This is your reward for saving my brother."

An arrogant, intimidating, and merciless constellation toward the incarnations who worshipped him. Of all the Poseidons I knew, none had a back view like this.

"Take that guy and escape quickly."

For a moment, I wanted to ask. What on earth was he thinking?

"I just thought you were right. I can't die in a place like this."

As if answering my question, Poseidon shouted.

"I am Poseidon of <Olympus>. The spear that marks the boundaries of the seas, and one of the three great main gods!"

Poseidon let out a lion's roar and charged at the men. However, it was a fight no match for an old man. Being unilaterally beaten all over his body, Poseidon quickly lost his strength and slumped down.

「And a machete began to fall upon Poseidon's head.」

Along with the sensation that the flow of space-time was slowing down little by little, I felt as if my surroundings were turning colorless.

A sentence describing a predetermined ending.

I glared at that sentence. I hate Poseidon. I hate the constellations of <Olympus>. But they, too, were characters in this story. At least—

「As long as I am the 'writer'.」

A dazzling beam of light settled in my hand. I reached out my hand toward the sentence before me.

「The blade of the machete, having fallen mercilessly, shattered Poseidon's head.」

I gripped the end of the sentence and applied force as if inserting a lever.

「The machete blade fell mercilessly.」

A fierce spark shot up right before my eyes. The sound of a predetermined ending twisting. The sound of a completed destiny shattering. And then,

「The machete blade fell mercilessly and grazed Poseidon's earlobe.」

The machete blade missed Poseidon and struck the floor. The panicked man in the suit struggled with all his might to pull the machete out of the ground. And Poseidon, having witnessed all of this right before his eyes, turned to look at me. He must have seen it. The very moment his destiny was changing.

"How—"

It works. Although it consumes mental energy, my 'Revision' ability works here.

"How can you wield such power here—"

Poseidon muttered, looking at me with trembling eyes.

"To handle such probability… Surely not—"

Looking at Poseidon, I was reminded of Mithra. Mithra, who could not bring himself to jump into the 'Bush of Missing People'. Like him, the other myth-grade constellations likely felt the same way. That is why they were able to send only fragments of themselves into this world.

"That is right."

But I was different.

「This is a power that can only be possessed by those who have the courage to go completely 'missing' outside the world.」

The story residing within me was speaking. I have a duty to perform here.

"I have staked my entire being here."

I slowly rose from my seat, gazing at Poseidon and the constellations. Then, the abandoned star fragments looked up at me as well.

Story fragments that could have become stories, but were cast aside by the Main Body.

I do not particularly pity them. I simply felt it was a waste for a story to end in such a predictable way.

[A new story begins to germinate within you!]

And so, I imagine. A dream in which these fragments somehow survive. Those cast aside by the Main Body in this prison. A story of venturing into the outside world.

「I am the 'One Who Rewrites Eternity'.」

The world I slowly opened was filled with sentences.

"I."

Reaching out my hand toward one of those sentences, I said.

"Will rewrite your myths."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 995 Episode 60 Star Fragments (3)

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"You say 'write'?"

In an instant, the look in the eyes of the stars staring at me changed.

"Surely... you are a recorder?"

A recorder. One of the constellations, having realized my true identity, muttered.

"How did a recorder get into this place with a physical body?"

The Myth-grade constellations seemed unable to discern my true identity.

Come to think of it, it was strange. After all, I had already made quite a name for myself in the 'New Murim Earth'.

There, I had half-destroyed the 'Black Library Society', a record alliance that had contracted with [Veda], and even defeated Agni, one of the Lokapala, alongside Jung Heewon.

"You bastard, what exactly is your identity..."

The fact that they do not know me despite this might mean they were trapped here much earlier than I thought. Or perhaps recent information was cut off as the link with the main

body was severed.

"Wait. Surely not."

It was not the Myth-grade constellations who noticed my true identity first, but the new intruders.

"Deal with that guy first!"

Perseus, recognizing the power I had manifested, shouted in shock.

"He is using the power of recorders!"

Were there other Hero-grade or Legendary-grade constellations possessing bodies here besides Perseus? The men, sensing the command, immediately swung their machetes at me. I narrowly dodged a blade grazing my head and snatched an unfinished sentence from the air.

「And Jung Heewon's」

Then, I filled in the blank space with a single stroke of the brush.

「And Jung Heewon's body moved like the wind. The swirling wooden sword snapped the ankles of the surrounding men like straw.」

In an instant, Jung Heewon moved abnormally, as if the scene had been fast-forwarded at double speed. The wooden sword swept the floor, creating a gale, and the screaming men in suits collapsed one after another. Amidst the hazy cloud of dust, Jung Heewon stared at me with piercing eyes.

「Jung Heewon is ready to accept my records.」

Jung Heewon has entered into a [Record Contract] with me. The cost of revising [Fate] based on my records was significantly lower.

Then, what about the constellations?

"Are you just going to keep watching like that?"

I glanced at the Myth-grade constellations standing awkwardly, watching the situation, and spoke.

"I will accept support. If even a single one of you has the courage to fight back—"

Tsutsu—sparks erupted from my entire body.

"I will rewrite the myth of that star."

Countless emotions crossed the pupils of the stars looking at me.

「Rewrite the myth.」

Some blushed as if considering it an insult, while others shook their heads in fear.

"Fine, go ahead and try."

In the midst of this, there was one star who staggered to his feet.

"If there is still a story left to be written on this damned body, you try writing it!"

Poseidon's voice, filled with rage, echoed loudly through the dining room.

A star that once ruled the oceans. The absolute ruler who subjugated all Narrative-grade constellations merely by descending into the scenario.

And now, he stood before me with a body that looked as though it could barely withstand a tailwind, let alone a storm.

"How is it? Do you see it? Do you think there is still a damn possibility left for me?!"

I gazed at Poseidon—or more precisely, at the fragment Poseidon had discarded.

The fragment that saved his wife, Demeter, from the flames and reached out to his brother, Zeus. Yet, it was a fragment discarded by its original form for being 'useless'.

I bit my lip tightly. If that story is deemed 'useless', then what on earth is a 'useful' story in this <Star Stream>?

「Here, he was not the 'Spear that Marks the Boundaries of the Seas'.」

Just because one is a recorder does not mean they can write every sentence. The probability of this world is based on the Third's imagination—or 'realism'. Therefore, even if I were to write here that Poseidon 'makes a full descent', that sentence could not be realized.

"Kill him! He is just an ordinary old man!"

He could no longer wield the Trident as in the myth, nor could he part the ocean.

But does that mean that old man is powerless?

「Poseidon smiled silently and pulled his Marine cap down low.」

I didn't think that a fragment of Poseidon had accidentally possessed that old man's body.

「A salty scent began to wash over from somewhere.」

A man in a suit, having caught the unfamiliar smell of the sea, flinched in surprise and muttered.

"Um, can I really hit him?"

Perseus seemed to sense the change in Poseidon's demeanor. Soon, as if having made a decision, Perseus shouted.

"Burn him!"

Following this, a large number of men in suits carrying Molotov cocktails appeared from outside. It seemed that the Molotov cocktails they had thrown were the very ones that had set the abandoned factory ablaze earlier.

With a crashing sound, fire spread across the dining area in an instant. Amidst the acrid smoke, several constellations knelt and collapsed to the ground. It was a situation where it was clear that everyone would either suffocate or burn to death if things continued like this. I began writing with a mixture of skepticism and doubt.

「He quietly blew his broken horn.」

In this world, neither magic nor skills exist.

「And so, when the Sea God's horn sounded again.」

However, it clearly permitted superhuman feats of strength, such as those of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal or Jung Heewon.

「The sea shall soon become a disaster.」

In other words, the probability of this world is based on a somewhat crude realism. My idea stemmed from that very point.

Skills or magic are out of the question. Then, what if it were something that looked like a 'skill' or 'magic'?

For instance—

「The sea poured out from Poseidon's mouth.」

Magic. Or perhaps 'magical realism'.

"What?"

Poseidon, having confirmed the record I had written, glared.

Of course, I did not allow that and added another layer to the sentence.

「The sea poured out of Poseidon's mouth.」

Just as Poseidon was about to let out a roar of rage, something else spewed from his mouth first.

"Aaaargh! What is this!"

Water with enough pressure to be called a water cannon erupted explosively from Poseidon's mouth toward the men. The stream of water extinguished all the fires in the area and knocked down even the men in suits who were rushing at him.

Pale white, as if he had drained every drop of moisture from his body, Poseidon collapsed to his knees in exhaustion.

I then summoned another constellation.

"Demeter!"

Demeter, whose eyes met mine, held an armful of seeds used in the smart farm in her bosom.

「Demeter threw the seeds at the men.」

Normally, it would have looked like the desperate struggle of a cute old lady. It wasn't as if she were exorcising demons, so what damage could she possibly inflict on sturdy men by throwing seeds?

However, the one who threw those seeds was Demeter, the 'Ruler of Agriculture and Seasons', and magic was unfolding right before our eyes.

「The seeds imbued with the history of the earth have finally finished preparing to germinate.」

Demeter's seeds, having absorbed Poseidon's seawater, bloomed in unison. Vine plants that grew alongside the dense greenery instantly bound the movements of the men in suits.

"This is unbelievable—"

Both the men and the constellations were left speechless by the miraculous scene unfolding before their eyes.

「Can this be called a myth?」

It is likely not the myth the stars expect. But at least, all the myths I knew began with small miracles. Water gushing forth where there is none, seeds that were not supposed to bloom coming to life. To savor and record that simple and gentle joy.

「In the ruins abandoned by the stars, a small seed of myth was germinating.」

A faint sense of weariness washed over me, but it was not over yet. To fend off Perseus, who was approaching by cutting through vines with a machete, I now needed the help of the last star.

I expected Poseidon and Demeter to cooperate. But even I could not be certain about him.

"Zeus!"

Nevertheless, I called out to Zeus. It was not because I trusted in his petty loyalty or kindness.

「He is the star who has guarded and cared for the myths of Olympus for a very long time.」

What I believed in was the 'protagonist' of the Olympian myths.

「Standing there was Zeus, the one-armed electrician.」

"I am not doing this because I acknowledge you."

I could not tell what Zeus was thinking or what was on his mind as he stood there. However, the moment I saw Zeus's back, I realized that he already understood his role.

"I."

The 'Seat of Lightning', who has monopolized that role because he knew better than anyone in this <Star Stream> where a myth would bloom.

"I simply want to punish my son myself."

Zeus pulled pliers from his bosom and hurled them with all his might toward the electrical panel. Amidst the men screaming, the sound of something snapping was heard.

「All the lights in the abandoned factory flickered in unison, as if the world itself were blinking.」

Patcheu—the current shot through the air.

I shouted reflexively.

"Everyone, get down!"

A furious current shot down from the ceiling of the abandoned factory and plunged onto the floor. It was like a bolt of lightning striking from the sky. Amidst the feast of agonizing screams, a terrible stench of burning skin filled the air.

The flickering current finally subsided, and the factory's emergency power was activated. Beneath the pale light, men whose entire bodies had turned pitch black lay sprawled like dead fish. Zeus gasped for breath without a word and glared at the fallen face of Perseus. In the silence where the stars seemed to hold their breath, only the silent sound of rain filled the air.

With a splashing sound, Poseidon slowly rose from the ground and spoke.

"Not bad. Thanks to you, I recalled a memory from a very long time ago..."

With a bang, one wall of the abandoned factory collapsed, and a large refrigerated truck emerged. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, still driving as if he were piloting a magic cloud, poked his head out the window.

"No one is dead yet, right? Hurry up and get in."

I could see Perseus, pinned under the wheels, his hands trembling uncontrollably.

Jung Heewon ended up driving the truck.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal boarded the refrigerated compartment with me and listened to the events that had unfolded in such a short time.

"So, you used the power of a recorder."

"You don't seem very surprised."

"I knew you were a recorder from the moment you first entered."

We gazed at the constellations huddled individually on the floor of the truck. Their faces were still those of frail old men, yet their eyes held a strangely elevated look. Perhaps the mythical landscape they had witnessed previously had brought about some kind of change within them.

"Did you know what would happen if you brought me here?"

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal nodded with a bitter expression. It was a look that seemed to say that he had desired this outcome, yet at the same time, he had wished it would not turn out this way.

"Now Zeus, Poseidon, and Demeter will be able to use their full power."

One waters, another grows seeds, and the remaining one can use electricity. Although it was a miracle classified merely as magic, I thought it was still something to have this much power.

"Those three are probably all that can be used."

"Why?"

"Most of those guys can't even properly remember who they are."

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke, observing Odin, who was staring blankly into the void, and the other constellations.

"It's like Alzheimer's in humans."

The fragments of the mythical constellations could not function as precisely as Han Sooyoung's [Avatar]. The Great Sage explained that most of them had either

malfunctioned like Odin due to the prolonged disconnection from their main bodies, or had partially forgotten their memories of the <Star Stream>.

"Ugh—"

Turning around at a low groan, I saw Dansu ahjussi opening his eyes, having regained consciousness.

"Ahjussi, are you alright?"

I gently supported Dansu ahjussi and gave him a little water I had brought from the cafeteria. After lightly wetting his throat, Dansu ahjussi's condition was noticeably better than before. Feeling a strange sensation for a moment, I quickly examined his wound.

「The size of the wound has shrunk noticeably.」

It was impossible. Dansu ahjussi had clearly suffered a wound that was close to a serious injury. For such a wound to heal this quickly...

"I knew my friend would be able to pull it off."

As if he had heard my words even in his dazed state, Dansu ahjussi smiled while holding my hand.

I put my thoughts aside for a moment, nodded at him, and replied.

"It is a method I wouldn't have even thought of if it weren't for you."

Who would have known? That I would join hands with Zeus or Poseidon.

Dansu ahjussi quietly shook his head and spoke in a slightly languid voice.

"It wasn't something I came up with."

"Huh?"

"I met Kim Dokja just once, while he was living in my friend's body."

For a moment, I couldn't understand what he was saying. Then I realized.

Kim Dokja, who had been living in this body. Dansu ahjussi had actually spoken to the 'Third Kim Dokja'.

"It was before I was imprisoned. It was only once, but I had a brief conversation with him."

"What did you talk about?"

Dansu ahjussi glanced at the Great Sage Heaven's Equal at my question. Watching the Great Sage pretend to pick his ear, Dansu ahjussi spoke.

"He asked if there wasn't an ending where everyone gets along well."

I could feel the Great Sage's body trembling faintly at Dansu ahjussi's words. Perhaps the Great Sage was hearing this story for the first time, too.

"What did you tell him?"

"I answered that it would probably be difficult."

"What did Kim Dokja say?"

"He asked if it might be possible if we really pushed it."

I imagined the Third Kim Dokja who would have conveyed those words to Dansu ahjussi. With that very expression Dansu ahjussi is making right now, the Third would have said:

"When you look up at the sky, the universe is vast, and the stars are so beautiful."

In this world of the <Star Stream> where the sky is invisible, he must have imagined it relying on the light of a single star.

"Isn't there such a thing as an ending where everyone lives happily together in a very big house?"

An ending where everyone lives happily together in a huge house. It was certainly a beautiful story.

「But why do I have such an ominous premonition after hearing that story?」

Seeing my expression, Dansu ahjussi suddenly spoke.

"Friend."

"Yes?"

"I'm sorry."

Before I could even ask what that meant, sparks began to fly in the air with a 'tsutsu' sound. The startled constellations murmured, and the Great Sage, his expression hardening, sprang to his feet. We immediately stepped out of the truck.

The smartphone in my pocket buzzed. As soon as I answered, the Eldest's voice pierced my ears.

—You idiot! What on earth have you done!

"Yes?"

—What are you going around recording?!

I suddenly recalled the fact that this world was created by the Third's imagination.

「Perhaps the Third has read my records, too.」

I looked at a high-rise building in the city center in the distance. From the upper floors of the building, I saw an ominous swirling vortex. It was a dazzling vortex, as if all the starlight in the universe had been gathered into one.

—Get out of there! Right now!

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke.

"It was bound to happen."

Hearing the Great Sage's sigh, I realized a fact I had forgotten.

「This damned <Star Stream> turns even someone's wish to 'see the ending' into a scenario.」

And if the 'Oldest Dream' dreams of it—

[Soon, a n■w sc■nar■o will b■gin.]

That 'dream' will surely come true.

「Atop a towering skyscraper in the city center, a man in a white coat stood.」

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 996 Episode 60 Star Fragments (4)

The place where he opened his eyes was a pure white room. A room so white it made his eyes ache, reminiscent of a sterile room. Inside that room, he lay there all alone, like a person who had suddenly come into existence.

「The third Kim Dokja thought. No. There is no such thing as a person who suddenly comes into existence.」

Watching the sentence floating in the air, he realized it was a description of himself.

「He remembers everything—the 'why' and 'how' of his arrival here.」

Three days had already passed since he first entered this place.

「During that time, he read only one story.」

The Third knew exactly which story he had read. On the floor where he had slept, the book lay upside down, its spine exposed.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

He spent his time in this white void devouring that story. He slept when exhaustion took him and read the moment his eyes opened. He felt no hunger here.

The books stored on the simple bookshelf were classified by language editions from various countries. Since Korean was the only language he could comprehend, he had chosen the Korean edition.

「Today was the turn to read the final chapter of that book.」

He had been overwhelmed by a torrent of thoughts while devouring the text.

「"Kim Dokja, you only get one chance."」

「"For me, it was always only once."」

Certain parts of the book made his heart tremble, while others filled him with a terrible, hollow sadness.

「"Kim Dokja said he read that novel when he was fifteen."」

At times the prose was tender; at others, it carried a heart-wrenching longing.

「"What if that guy can't read that novel?"」

He also felt an endless, aching desire to see someone.

「"So, you're saying we should show the novel written here to Dokja ahjussi from another worldline? Is my understanding correct?"」

When he finally reached the last chapter, he inadvertently stopped.

Why? He felt as though he shouldn't read this story to the very end. It felt as if he wouldn't be able to compose himself if he finished the final page. Swept away by the wave of stories surging from an unknown source, he feared he would never be able to rise back to the surface.

「Too much time has passed.」

It struck him once again that he had remained here for far too long.

「The third Kim Dokja thought. 'My eldest brother must be looking for me.'」

The image of Wukong wandering around, searching for him with a grim expression, flashed through his mind.

By now, the house must be turned upside down. Not just Wukong, but Hyunsung and Heewon must be looking for him as well.

「I have to go back.」

After deep contemplation, he put down the book and looked up.

"Huh? Aren't you going to read any further?"

He wondered when it had started. Someone was looking down at him. The man had pure white skin that matched the space and wore a neatly draped white coat.

"That is where the truly touching part begins."

The Third opened his eyes wide.

He was surprised for two reasons: the man looked remarkably similar to himself, and his attire perfectly mirrored the protagonist from the novel he had been reading.

"Who are you?"

He asked after a moment of hesitation.

Although he had arrived here, he did not know who the owner of this place was. The man who had initially brought him here was a completely different person.

「"Friend, the things you have been wondering about all along are written in that story. Go to the place the book told you about."」

The person who had revealed the secrets of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 to him. He, too, had been a trustworthy person, and for that reason, the Third had followed his advice without suspicion. He had lost consciousness while searching for the location described in the book, and when he woke, he was here.

"This is my house."

"Your house?"

The Third looked around slowly before speaking.

"It is a very big house."

"That is exactly the sad part."

He looked intently at the man. He bore a striking resemblance to himself. As he gazed quietly into the man's eyes, he felt as though he were being sucked into the distant, cold reaches of the universe.

"You are..."

"I'm Kim Dokja."

Kim Dokja—that was his own name as well. Yet, for some reason, when this man said 'Kim Dokja', the Third felt as though his name had been stolen. The name seemed to suit the man before him much better than it did himself.

"It's the same name as mine."

"Not the same."

Kim Dokja grinned.

"Because I am 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'."

"Snowfield Kim Dokja?"

"The guy I like calls me that. You can call me Snowfield if you prefer."

As if pleased with the nickname, Snowfield nodded and asked.

"What should I call you?"

"I..."

「The third thought of his name.」

Reading the sentence floating in the air, he decided on his title.

"Please call me Third."

"Alright."

Snowfield and the Third looked at each other for a moment.

The Third was the first to speak. Looking down at the book he had stopped reading, he asked.

"You are the protagonist of this story, aren't you?"

"No, I am someone who wanted to be the protagonist."

The Third couldn't understand what that meant. Snowfield shook his head lightly, as if it were of no consequence, and asked.

"What about you?"

"Me?"

"Didn't you want to be the protagonist while reading?"

The Third pondered for a moment.

Certainly, while reading the story, the Third felt like he had briefly become the lead. He had cleared the scenarios and stood with his companions, feeling like he had become the Kim Dokja within the pages.

"I didn't want to be the protagonist."

"Really? Aren't you resentful?"

"Resentful?"

"Why should the protagonist be another 'Kim Dokja' instead of me? Don't you feel that way?"

The Third found it difficult to grasp those words. Instead, he gave a different answer.

"I actually prefer watching other people."

"Watch?"

"This story is like that, too."

The Third continued speaking while looking at the folded spine of the book.

"The protagonist is Kim Dokja, but actually, Kim Dokja reads and watches over the other characters."

The Third spoke briefly about the latter part of the story's ending. The protagonist splitting into countless fragments, and the characters struggling through the scenarios to reclaim him.

"The protagonist gave up his place to make others the protagonists."

As if finding that interpretation interesting, Snowfield nodded slightly.

"But did the protagonist really want to give up his place?"

"Huh?"

"He finally knew the warmth of that position. He barely understood what it meant to be loved. Do you think he really wanted to step down from it?"

The Third remained silent.

The two Kim Dokjas looked at each other once again. The Third's eyes slowly widened. He asked in a trembling voice,

"You are 'that Kim Dokja'."

Snowfield remained silent. His silence was his affirmation. The Third asked,

"Did the scattered Kim Dokjas return at the end?"

"The end of that book is an open ending."

"Wait a minute, that's a spoiler."

"You would have found out anyway."

Snowfield chuckled and began walking leisurely around the white space.

"I wandered the universe collecting various editions of this book. I was curious if I might see a different ending in another universe."

Only then did the Third understand why so many different editions of the book were shelved on the white bookshelf.

"So, was there an ending you were looking for?"

"No."

The Third felt a distant resonance in that answer. It was a resonance transmitted from a primordial source he was unaware of.

"That is why I felt I had to write it myself."

"You?"

Snowfield did not answer. In that silence, the Third felt an inexplicable threat. This white space, which he had initially perceived as merely peculiar, began to feel alien and dangerous.

"Why did you bring me here?"

"Because I need you to complete the story."

"Because I, too, am one of the countless fragmented Kim Dokjas?"

Snowfield nodded. Watching that nod, the Third recalled the actions of his brothers that he had been unable to understand until now.

His brothers had been trying to protect him from this story. They had been making efforts unknown to him to block this information and keep him safe in a sheltered world.

"In the end, you found me."

"Yes."

"Am I going to die now?"

"No, you are going to read the book."

Saying this, Snowfield picked up the volume the Third had set aside.

"You are going to finish this book."

"I don't want to read it."

The Third shook his head and pleaded.

"Please send me back. I want to meet my brothers."

"Your brothers are all here."

Saying this, Snowfield took off his coat. His chest was visible through his black shirt. Sentences etched like tattoos within his skin were rippling deeply.

"Your brothers—who had to endure a terrible scenario and become sacrifices to dreams while you were hiding here—are all here."

The metallic scent of blood wafted from somewhere. The Third recoiled in fear. But his feet kept sinking deeper and deeper, as if he were walking through a heavy snowfield.

Snowfield approached him.

"You must read the book for everyone. You must finish Kim Dokja's work."

The book he had stopped reading unfolded right before his eyes.

"And imagine the dream we have longed for so much."

The Third struggled desperately to escape. But his gaze was already fixed on the pages. Like someone born to read it, his eyes greedily devoured the sentences. His breathing became ragged, and his heart beat with a strange, frantic rhythm.

「I will write the final chapter for you forever and ever.」

The page turned of its own accord. As the unfolded sentence seeped into his vision, the Third froze. All he could do was read. Read and read again.

And so, he finally reached the final chapter of the story.

「The story she had not yet finished was there. A sentence she had wanted to write someday, if not now. Thinking of that sentence, Han Sooyoung smiled like a fool.」

The moment he read that sentence, the Third shed tears. Deeply accumulated longing and sorrow festered and flowed. Why does the story end here?

Why is an open ending not open to him?

「The universe was opening up before his eyes.」

Dazzling rays of light streamed from the Third's entire body. It was a light so brilliant and beautiful it was astonishing to think such a thing had been hidden within him.

「The Third realized what he had to imagine.」

He felt the world creaking and the universe twisting.

"Next."

The Third asked.

"What will happen?"

The Third understood everything now. The reason Snowfield had sought him out, the reason Kim Dokja fragments existed, and the tragedy unfolding across the entire universe as a result.

Snowfield asked.

"Are you curious about the ending?"

The Third hesitated. Depending on his answer, the fate of the universe would change.

"Can I see the ending too?"

"It is possible if you help me. Then what happens?"

"The scenario will begin."

Snowfield said with a smile.

"All the Kim Dokjas will gather, and finally, a single dream will be born again."

A single dream.

The Third slowly closed his eyes and imagined a certain scene. As if adding color to that landscape, Snowfield whispered.

"Everyone Kim Dokja loved will gather here."

A thud echoed from somewhere. The Third snapped his eyes open. It was not a sound coming from inside this room.

Thump.

The sound echoed once again.

Snowfield stared toward the source with a strangely hardened expression, then let out a deep, low sigh.

"The person we've been waiting for is coming."

As Snowfield lightly waved his hand, a small screen appeared in the air.

「"Block them! Block them no matter what!"」

At the entrance, which appeared to be the first floor of the building, people were fighting against men in suits. The first to catch his eye were Wukong and Heewon.

Wukong was recklessly fending off the men in suits while repeatedly calling out a name.

「"Youngest!"」

Following them, other figures came into view. An old man wearing a Marine Corps cap spitting water, an old man scattering seeds, and another zapping people with a stun gun.

And at the center of those old men stood a man who bore a striking resemblance to Kim Dokja.

"The protagonist."

The Third blurted the words out without realizing it. Snowfield nodded in response.

"Our brother will arrive soon."

The air shook violently. The space distorted uneasily, and something was trying to cross over into this place.

Snowfield said with a dazzling smile,

"Let's build a 'big house' for everyone."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 997 Episode 60 Star Fragments (5)

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"It's over there!"

We rode the refrigerated truck driven by Jung Heewon straight toward the high-rise building.

「We must not let the scenario begin.」

I was certain of one thing, if nothing else.

「We must not let the 'something' I am thinking of burst out from beyond that vortex.」

With the sound of tires grinding, the truck came to a stop. As the Great Sage Heaven's Equal kicked open the truck door and stepped out, we saw men in suits rushing toward us as if they had been waiting. the Great Sage Heaven's Equal swiftly knocked one of the men down, then swung the iron pipe he was holding like a staff and shouted.

"That is the building. Go inside!"

The men in suits surrounded the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and attacked him. Amidst the mercilessly ringing sounds of gunfire, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's lion's roar could be heard.

"Youngest! Can you hear me!"

Hearing that desperate cry, we entered the building through the opening that the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had made.

「'Kim Dokja' is on the rooftop of this building.」

It was a skyscraper that looked at least 50 stories tall at first glance. I immediately checked for the elevator. However, the area in front of the elevator was packed with people. On top of that, there were men in suits chasing us. If we got on the elevator and were trapped inside, this world would end right here.

"Let's take the stairs."

At Jung Heewon's words, we turned toward the emergency staircase. Since many of our group were elderly, we wanted to avoid the stairs at all costs, but we had no choice.

"Don't worry! My body is hardened by walking 10,000 steps every day!"

Poseidon, adjusting his Marine Corps cap, shouted boldly as he walked past me. Indeed, does the God of the Sea climb stairs well? I don't know where on earth he walked 10,000 steps while being trapped in an abandoned factory all this time, but—following the constellations letting out thunderous shouts, I climbed the stairs feeling like the youngest member of a hiking club. Honestly, climbing stairs was torture for me, too. And 50 floors to begin with. With a body that couldn't even use the system, it was a height no different from Mount Everest.

「Kim Dokja thought.」

He simply couldn't hold back his rising breath without writing it down.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

I wondered if I really needed to be Yoo Joonghyuk just for something as trivial as climbing stairs, but there was no other way right now.

"Hah, hah, damn it."

We had climbed just over ten floors when Poseidon and Zeus, who were a few steps ahead, gasped for breath and bent over. Demeter, feeling dizzy, was also supported by Dansu ahjussi. You really can't hide your age.

"What are you doing? Why aren't you coming quickly?"

Jung Heewon, who had been running at the front, shouted as she looked down at the landing. Her entire body was covered in someone's blood, suggesting the cleanup upstairs was already finished. She grabbed my wrist and pulled me along, glancing at the constellations behind her.

"Leave them behind. You said there was no time."

It seemed Jung Heewon hadn't placed much hope in the constellations to begin with. However, I couldn't simply cast aside even a small part of my strength.

"Heewon-ssi, over here!"

The emergency exit on the stairwell opened, and the men in suits who had been waiting rushed in. As Jung Heewon swung her wooden sword to push them back, screams began to be heard from the floor below. The constellations, caught by the tail, were being brutally beaten by the men in suits.

Finally, unable to stand it any longer, Poseidon stepped forward.

「Poseidon let out the breath he had been holding.」

Toward the men charging in with a human wave, Poseidon began spitting water from his mouth.

"Oooooh!"

The men in suits, suddenly struck by a water cannon mixed with Poseidon's saliva, recoiled in anger. The cannon soon turned into a weak stream of water.

"Cough, darling, just a glass of water—"

Demeter, holding a water bottle nearby, quickly gave Poseidon some water.

"Hit him now!"

While Poseidon hesitated, the men in suits had come right up to his face. Poseidon, whose water cannon hadn't finished recharging yet, stood awkwardly, clutching a broken recorder.

It was Zeus, who had been watching all this time, who pushed Poseidon aside and stepped forward.

Tsutsutsutsutsu!

The sound of an electric shocker striking the floor. The men, electrocuted in succession, recoiled in shock and fainted. However, only the men in the front row had collapsed. The lower floor was still packed with men in suits chasing us. Constellations and men were engaged in a chaotic battle all around.

"Leave us behind. It will be troublesome if we get delayed."

Demeter spoke to me, looking at me. It was the first time she had spoken in such a clear voice, so I listened to her with a slight surprise.

"I don't know what is going on, but you are likely the only one here who can stop 'him'."

Demeter spoke as if she knew who was waiting for me on this rooftop.

"I will chase after them soon. I have no intention of yielding this myth to you."

Zeus added, growling as well. Judging by the situation, it seemed I should leave this place to them and head up.

I exchanged glances with Dansu ahjussi and Jung Heewon, then immediately went upstairs.

Before I knew it, the floor count had passed the 20th and then the 30th. However, the situation was not going smoothly. Just as we reached the 35th floor, we came face-to-face with a massive wall in the middle of the landing.

Upon closer inspection, it wasn't a wall, but a human back.

"Hyunsung-ssi?"

Lee Hyunsung, his eyes strangely clouded, turned to look at me.

"Dokja-ssi... I'm sorry."

"Yes?"

Just as I thought something was off, Jung Heewon pushed me aside and ran forward. At the same time, Lee Hyunsung, who had rushed forward, collided with Jung Heewon in the middle. Lee Hyunsung's fist and Jung Heewon's wooden sword clashed, and the broken tip of the sword tumbled across the floor.

"Heewon-ssi! Hyunsung-ssi!"

I quickly used 「Revision」.

「Lee Hyunsung realized belatedly what he had done.」

But for some reason, Lee Hyunsung could not regain his senses.

Jung Heewon, rolling on the floor and struggling with Lee Hyunsung, shouted.

"This person is unconscious!"

"Dokja-ssi, I'm sorry..."

Lee Hyunsung, who was merely repeating the same words. He was currently in a state where normal 'record execution' was impossible.

「Someone must have put Lee Hyunsung in that state.」

"Go up! I'll hold him!"

「i have no choice but to leave Lee Hyunsung to Jung Heewon.」

Jung Heewon's gaze changed completely upon receiving my record. Throwing away the broken wooden sword, Jung Heewon clutched the telescopic baton thrown by the men in suits.

"And—"

Every time Lee Hyunsung's fist and Jung Heewon's baton clashed, a voice called out to me.

"Because I wanted to fight this person at least once."

[The O■dae sto■ry ■ is dream■ng./오■된 ■대 설■가 꿈■거■고 있습■다.]

The power of the story was growing stronger. The story of <Kim Dokja Company> was reacting. I could feel the gravitational pull of the story intensifying. If I delay any longer here, another <Kim Dokja Company> member might really come here as well.

"Please."

Before that, I had to reach the rooftop of the building and stop 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

44th floor, 45th floor… We continued running upwards. Dansu ahjussi gasped for breath but never once showed a hint of fatigue. Just as we reached the 46th floor, I glanced back at him and asked.

"Ahjussi."

"Yes."

"About what you said earlier..."

In the truck, Dansu ahjussi apologized to me.

"Did you happen to give the 'Book' to Kim Dokja in this world?"

Dansu ahjussi nodded without showing any signs of being flustered.

"That is correct."

"Are you going to stop me?"

If it is certain that Dansu ahjussi gave the Book to the Third, then he is ultimately helping 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

His profile suddenly felt unfamiliar. He was still my friend, but at the same time, he was the Lee Dansu who had lived for eight years I was unaware of.

"I have no intention of doing that, friend."

Dansu ahjussi shook his head coolly and gazed at the marker indicating the ascent to the 47th floor.

"Because I understand why my friend wants to see the end of this world."

I nodded, too.

There must be a reason why he is being honest with me. Perhaps he is in a state where it is difficult for him to take a definite side, either me or Snowfield Kim Dokja.

"However, there is still something I cannot give up."

I thought about what he cannot give up. It was probably about the person he has been searching for all along.

「Noh Kyunghwan's daughter, Jiyoon.」

His daughter—Jiyoon's soul is in the theater of 'Asmodeus'. If so, perhaps he has decided to get Jiyoon back in exchange for delivering the 'Book' to the third child.

"Friend."

However, the moment we reached the 48th floor, Dansu ahjussi's expression changed. I, too, stopped in my tracks. An ominous vibration was spreading throughout the entire building. We looked out the window. Just as the sunlight seemed to vanish in an instant, a massive shadow enveloped the building. Screams could be heard from somewhere. The sensation of the unreality becoming reality. The downy hairs on my body stood on end.

「Something escaped from that 'sky'.」

With a deafening roar, the building's exterior wall was torn off in its entirety. I crouched in the thick dust, gripping the handrail on the landing. Sparks of probability raging in the void. When I opened my eyes again, I saw the piercing eyes of a monstrous creature through a crack in the shattered exterior wall.

「The probability of the world was collapsing.」

It was a monster I knew well.

The Beast Lord's partner.

The Mad Dragon, who had understood her sorrow longer than anyone else, was there.

「Chimera Dragon.」

The moment I looked into its eyes, I realized. That 'Chimera Dragon' was not in its right mind, just like Lee Hyunsung downstairs.

With a chilling sensation, I turned to look beside me.

"Ahjussi! Hurry—"

Dansu ahjussi, who had definitely been by my side until the end of the battle, was nowhere to be seen.

"Ahjussi?"

Ahjussi's shoes were rolling on the floor. A piece of debris that looked like his leg lay scattered across the ground. It felt as if the world had stopped.

"Ahjussi—"

The moment I stood up blankly and reached out my hand toward the traces of ahjussi, the Chimera Dragon opened its massive mouth toward me.

「Breath.」

The moment a fierce breath spewed from the Chimera Dragon's mouth.

Bang!

Someone struck its snout. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, with his dazzling golden hair fluttering in the wind, was struggling atop the Chimera Dragon's head.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, meeting my gaze, shouted.

"Go! Hurry!"

I shook my head. Even for you, it is impossible. With your current body, you cannot face a monster like that.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke.

"Have you forgotten who I am?"

Dazzling stories were shimmering across his entire body.

「And so, the King of the Stone Monkeys has finally regained his power.」

The golden robes that enveloped the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's entire body, Thunder flashed from the clouds enveloping his feet.

「Here, the darling of the Heavenly Realm shall once again display his might.」

Only then did I realize what had happened.

「The scales of probability have shifted.」

Now, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal has amplified his stature precisely on the scales of probability to the point of grandeur, while maintaining a precarious balance just enough

to prevent this world from collapsing.

"Calm down, demon! If your master knew you were doing this, he would be sad!"

While the Great Sage Heaven's Equal bought time, I hurriedly searched for Dansu ahjussi.

"Ahjussi!"

Dansu ahjussi was nowhere to be seen. He might have been swallowed by the Chimera Dragon, or he might have crashed to the ground. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal's voice rang out once again.

"Go! I will find that fellow!"

Right now, I have no choice but to trust the Great Sage Heaven's Equal. I have no choice but to believe that he will save ahjussi somehow. I started climbing the stairs again.

The 49th floor.

As I finally reached the top floor of the building, it felt as though I could smell the scent of winter from somewhere.

「Why did Snowfield Kim Dokja plan all of this?」

I recalled the moment I first encountered 'Snowfield'. I thought of the guy who used to cheer me on. I thought of the guy who liked warm tea, the guy who felt sad or happy at the story, and the guy who hated the 'Demon King of Salvation'.

「What exactly was the landscape he ultimately wanted to see through all this tragedy?」

A sign reading 'No Entry for Unauthorized Personnel' was posted in front of the door leading to the rooftop. It seemed as though the sign was speaking. That from here on, only those involved in this story are allowed to enter.

As if asking, "How dare someone like you call yourself an 'authorized person'?"

Certainly, in the past, I might have hesitated here. But not now. The history I had walked and the people I had loved were speaking for me.

「Unless he is involved in this story.」

I placed my hand on the doorknob without hesitation.

「Who could possibly speak of this story?」

As I opened the door, the expansive view of the rooftop came into sight. Standing there, where pure white snowflakes fluttered as if snow had fallen, was a man who looked better in a white coat than anyone else.

"You're late."

Snowfield Kim Dokja was there.

And beside him stood the third, who had been stripped of all his stories and reduced to the form of a small baby.

The third was sleeping peacefully, using a volume of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 as a pillow.

As if finding the third adorable, Snowfield Kim Dokja gently stroked his head and smiled, saying,

"Welcome to the big house."

The sky began to open.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 998 Episode 60 Star Fragments (6)

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Broken fragments were falling from the sky, which had cracked into pieces. It was the sight of the solid probability that had constituted this world collapsing.

I gazed up at the sky for a moment before opening my mouth.

"Kim Dokja."

As I called that name, Snowfield's eyes wavered slightly. I stared straight at him and said.

"You aren't this kind of person."

Snowfield laughed as if finding my words quite amusing and asked back.

"What kind of person am I?"

I thought about Snowfield.

I still don't know him well. I know he drinks tea, but I don't know why he started drinking it; I know he grew up in the Snowfield with Cheon Inho, but I don't know how long he endured the time there.

"Someone who hates Kim Dokja, but who actually wants to become Kim Dokja more than anyone else."

Nevertheless, I have watched him for a long time. From the beginning of the 41st round until now, I have felt his gaze watching over me.

"And."

Therefore, I could say this with certainty, at least.

"Someone who likes my story."

Snowfield nodded.

"I still like your story."

"Then stop here."

I said, watching Snowfield's fingertips. Every time his hand brushed against the small head of the third Kim Dokja, I could see the third Kim Dokja's story crumbling and being absorbed little by little.

Snowfield shook his head and said.

"I can't do that. Because this child wants it too."

"I don't think so."

I already knew, through the cases of the 'Demon King of Salvation' or the 'Great King of Fear', what happens when fragments of Kim Dokja are absorbed by another Kim Dokja.

The third, now a baby, was slowly losing his story, but he hadn't completely surrendered himself to Snowfield.

"If he really wanted it, he would have already been absorbed by you."

Instead of refuting my words, Snowfield let out a low sigh and said.

"He wants to see it, too. <Kim Dokja Company> gathering in one place."

"..."

"Now they will gather one by one. The 'Big House' that Kim Dokja so desperately longed for is finally being completed."

I recalled Lee Hyunsung, who had repeated my name like a round song, and the Chimera Dragon, roaring in a frenzy.

Thunder struck from somewhere. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal was exerting his power against the 'Chimera Dragon'.

"If you do that, this world will shatter. There is no way this fragile reality can handle the entirety of <Kim Dokja Company>."

The mere appearance of a single 'Chimera Dragon' had already jeopardized the probability of the world.

However, if the entirety of <Kim Dokja Company> were to gather here, the entire world would not be able to withstand the gravitational pull of the story and would explode.

"We'll have to try to know. It's something we've never attempted before."

Snowfield's expression was nonchalant. I couldn't tell what he was thinking.

Even if it were possible to gather the entire <Kim Dokja Company> as he claimed, what was the point of realizing that here?

In the end, I would have to return to the 41st round, and he…

For a moment, I felt my mind go cold.

「What was it that Snowfield Kim Dokja truly wanted?」

Perhaps he wasn't interested in the ending of the '41st round' in the first place; the fact that he laid down everything and descended upon the '41st round'—maybe— I bit my lip tightly and asked again.

"If the entire <Kim Dokja Company> is gathered? What are you going to do next?"

"I have to show them 'the one and only Kim Dokja'."

"Who is that 'one and only Kim Dokja'?"

The fact that those words had come out of my mouth felt strange. Yet, my mouth was moving on its own.

"So, you're saying you intend to become 'the one and only Kim Dokja'."

At that, Snowfield tilted his head.

"What's the problem with that?"

"I can't let it be like that."

"You can't let it be like that."

Snowfield quietly repeated my words, then wore a smile that was both knowing and enigmatic. Then, tilting his head at a subtle angle, he looked at me.

"Why are you saying that? Surely... you haven't come to want to become 'the one and only Kim Dokja' too?"

I couldn't answer.

Do I want to become 'the one and only Kim Dokja'?

"At the very least, I can't let you become one."

"Why? You know perfectly well who I am."

Those words pierced the corner of my heart painfully.

「He is the same '49% Kim Dokja' as me.」

I don't know 'how he has lived,' but I know 'how he was born'. Because he was born in the same way as me.

On the day the 'Oldest Dream', which had briefly become one, was torn to pieces, the day countless 'Kim Dokja fragments' became meteors and scattered across the entire universe, he and I were born into this story.

「Kim Dokja, who was not chosen by <Kim Dokja Company>.」

We originated from the same source of 'Kim Dokja'.

"I thought that at least you, my 'true brother', would understand me well."

"…"

"And I understand you, too. How you felt after knowing your true identity, and what thoughts you lived with—"

I shook my head.

"I told you to stop."

Because he was not just any other 'Kim Dokja', I had to prevent him from becoming 'the one and only Kim Dokja'.

「He is the 'Kim Dokja' who hates 'Kim Dokja' more than anyone else.」

I could not even dare to imagine what would happen to this entire universe if he became the one and only 'Oldest Dream'.

Gathering the power of 「Revision」 flickering at my fingertips, I slowly approached him. I was the only one who could stop him now. I could not rely on the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, nor on anyone else.

"What if you don't want to? What are you going to do?"

Snowfield smiled.

"Do you really think you can stop me?"

With that question, a formidable sense of pressure emanated from Snowfield's entire body. Sparks began to fly across the area due to the pressure, powerful enough to distort the probability of this world.

「An intimidation comparable to facing a myth-grade constellation.」

I realize it once again. The 'Snowfield' standing before me now is a being who has risen to a position equal to the 'Round Table' constellations I had encountered.

Nevertheless, I did not back down. Because I, too, now stand under the same sky as them.

As I continued to approach, a glint flickered in Snowfield's eyes. He gazed intently at me, then lightly snapped his fingers.

Tsutsutsutsutsu!

The next moment, the air split open, and two men appeared. As expected, they were men dressed in suits. Unusually, each man was wearing a mask on his face.

One wore a mask reminiscent of a white dragon, while the other had cheeks that resembled an unpleasant ghost. It was a mask.

"Is that him?"

As Snowfield nodded, the two men began to approach me.

"I'm sorry. I hold no particular grudge against you."

In that instant, I felt like I knew who they were.

「Stars that absorbed fragments of the snowfield and grew infinitely closer to a 'myth-grade constellation'.」

That 'White Dragon Mask' must be the 'White Flame Dragon of Lamentation', and the 'Ghost Mask' must be the 'Drinking Demon.' They, too, were introduced into this timeline along with Snowfield.

I prepared my logs with tension. But could I fight them with only the power of my 「Revision」 right now?

"Step back!"

Just as I smelled the sea from somewhere, the sound of a jet of water gushing out was heard. As I quickly bent down, I saw the White Flame Dragon and the Demon frown and retreat rapidly.

When I turned around, the constellations were there. The first ones to catch my eye were Poseidon and Zeus.

"Damn it, my knees almost gave out. Why is it so high?"

Constellations with piercing eyes were approaching this way. Demeter, Odin, and even the constellations whose names I do not yet know.

"I couldn't possibly miss a spectacle like this. Wouldn't you agree?"

To witness the end of this world, the stars had defeated all the men in suits and come this far.

Snowfield muttered as if surprised by the constellations.

"I didn't know they were still alive."

As if conscious of Snowfield's words, the 'White Flame Dragon of Lamentation' hurriedly opened its mouth.

"I apologize. We will handle this."

"So the vomit of myth-grade constellations has gathered here."

As the 'Drinking Demon' added in a voice of contempt, Poseidon scowled.

"Where do these guys—who haven't even heard of their modifier come from—"

And the 'Drinking Demon's' body moved. Before Poseidon could even finish speaking, the 'Drinking Demon', having advanced to within striking him, extended a lightning-fast fist toward the constellations.

"Cough."

The constellations were knocked out by a single blow.

Judging by their movements, both constellations appeared to be cases specialized in 'physical abilities', much like the Great Sage Heaven's Equal in this world.

The constellations did not back down and unleashed their strength. Poseidon fired a water cannon from his mouth, and Zeus unleashed an electric shock with a stun gun.

However, as if they had anticipated it, the two constellations dodged the attacks with swift footwork and subdued the constellations one by one.

"Aaaargh!"

The constellations with broken limbs screamed and slumped into the ground.

Poseidon looked at me.

"What are you doing! Run!"

I was already running, actually. Now was the perfect opportunity to approach Snowfield, as the constellations were buying me time.

"Where are you going in such a hurry?"

But the 'Drinking Demon' was much faster. Just as a large hand grabbed my shoulder, a chilling voice reached my ears.

"It wouldn't matter if I put a hole in your stomach."

The moment I hurriedly turned around, something pushed me hard. As I tumbled to my feet on the floor with a groan, I saw the startled face of the 'Drinking Demon'. The man who had taken his blow in my place was sprawled on the ground. Blood was gushing from the man's waist, his side flesh torn off in its entirety.

With a dazed look on my face, I called out to the man.

"Ahjussi?"

How could this have happened? Dansu ahjussi, who had disappeared after being attacked by the Chimera Dragon, was there. Even stranger was that Dansu ahjussi was naked.

"Now! Attack!"

The constellations, having regrouped, unleashed their supernatural powers upon the 'White Flame Dragon of Lamentation' and the 'Drinking Demon'.

"Ahjussi! Snap out of it! Ahjussi!"

I hurriedly shook Dansu ahjussi. His flank, torn off entirely, was in a state where his internal organs were completely ruptured and beyond repair. An irreversible, severe injury. No matter how resilient a person's life force, they could not survive with such a wound to the stomach.

"Don't worry, friend."

Nevertheless, Dansu ahjussi shook his head as if to say he was fine. And then, gasping for breath with a pale face, he added,

"I will not die."

The next moment, ahjussi's wounds began to heal little by little. Watching his wounds engulfed in dazzling rays of light, something suddenly struck me.

The other constellations had each awakened small special abilities, and just as I can use the power of 'Record', ahjussi must have also blossomed some ability.

And I felt I knew what that ability was.

"Is it the power of the 'King of Immortality'?"

Dansu ahjussi nodded.

"Go and do what my friend has to do."

A precious moment bought by the constellations and Dansu ahjussi, throwing themselves into the fray.

I nodded and ran straight toward Snowfield.

Just then, Snowfield saw me.

The moment his hand moved toward me, I swayed and dodged it. Judging by his movements, it seemed he, too, was a Chegeunmin 1, just like me.

Snowfield shouted.

"It's no use—"

But in the first place, what I was targeting wasn't Snowfield himself. Bending down, instead of attacking him, I immediately grabbed the small hand of the third Kim Dokja.

"Snap out of it! You mustn't get absorbed!"

Furious sparks began to fly in the air.

This world is ultimately sustained by the imagination of the 'third Kim Dokja'.

「To prevent the tragedy of this world, we must persuade the 'third Kim Dokja'.」

I thought about the third Kim Dokja. To understand him, I had to learn about his other brothers as well.

"The world you dream of is—"

The 'Demon King of Salvation' who had to save others for his own survival.

The 'Great King of Fear' who loved the stories abandoned in the <Star Stream>.

"It's not like that."

And before my eyes stood the last Kim Dokja, who had imprisoned himself to avoid getting involved in the strife between the brothers.

「He is the 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage'. 'Kim Dokja', who inherited the title of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.」

Trapped in this small prison, he must have long dreamed of a big house.

「In that world, the stars do not threaten humans.」

I looked back at the constellations fighting hard to help us.

「All stories that threaten the reader were intact only within the novel.」

I looked down at the single book supporting his small head—「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」.

A reader who wanted not to be a reader more than anyone else.

In this peaceful world, the dream he had was clear.

「He is the youngest of the five 'Sun Wukongs'.」

He is the Kim Dokja who wanted to form a 'family' more than any other Kim Dokja.

"Your family..."

His dream had already come true.

"They are already here."

Feeling young Kim Dokja's small hand wiggling, I thought of the people who have protected this world. I thought of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal who cried out for the youngest, and of Lee Hyunsung and Jung Heewon, who chose this world for Kim Dokja's sake.

They did not choose this ending because they had given up on finding Kim Dokja. It was simply that the Kim Dokja they found was in this world.

「They wanted to become Kim Dokja's family more than anyone else.」

Snowfield said.

"That's a lie."

At Snowfield's words, a small spark shot up in the air.

A lie.

That's right. This world isn't real. But the moment I watched this world, I kept thinking that.

「If so, to what extent was the world I lived in 'truth'?」

Star fragments discarded by the main body were brightly illuminating the dark night on the rooftop. Stories discarded as useless were becoming stories protecting someone here. And so, I thought.

「In this universe where everything is made up of mere 'stories', what value is there in distinguishing between 'real' and 'fake'?」

"If the story someone dedicated their entire life to is a lie."

「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, which had been supporting the third's head, began to tear little by little amidst the spark.」

"There is no such thing as truth in this world."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 999 Episode 60 Star Fragments (7)

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Context determines the meaning of a sentence.

What narrative has been built up to reach that sentence? What stories have contributed to each other?

I believed that Kim Dokja would understand the meaning hidden behind the sentences I was speaking.

"So, Kim Dokja, please protect this world."

Snowfield blinked at my words. Then, belatedly, he looked down.

Snowfield had realized. That the 'Kim Dokja' I had just asked for was not himself.

The 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, which the third Kim Dokja had cut, swayed precariously.

「"If a story someone dedicated their entire life to is a lie, then there is no such thing as truth in this world."」

I imagined what was happening inside the third's small head.

「Ultimately, this world is a massive 'incite'.」

As my recording ability was exerted to its extreme, the third's imagination was stretching out.

「The crumbling sky began to be restored little by little.」

The third had made a decision.

「Only he can protect this world.」

The world protected by the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, Jung Heewon, and Lee Hyunsung. The third one decided to protect that world together, and to restore the 'reality' of this world by mobilizing his imagination.

「The real and the fake do not matter.」

More than half of the pages of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 placed by the third one's bedside were now broken.

「He must have been curious. He must have wanted to know. He must have missed himself within the story, the companions who lived through it, and all those stories.」

Nevertheless, the third one decided not to be curious about that story anymore. He decided to live in this reality created by that story, in the world he had endured with his family. He decided to accept it as his own life.

「How could he do that?」

In fact, I, who had persuaded him, was also a little surprised. Perhaps it was because the third one's current decision was a choice that neither I nor Snowfield could have made.

Snowfield's eyes trembled violently. He, too, seemed greatly shaken by the fact that 'the Third Kim Dokja' had made this choice.

Tsutsutsutsu.

The vortex that had dominated the sky was gradually shrinking. From a distance, the sound of the 'Chimera Dragon' losing its power could be heard. The movements of the constellations, the 'White Flame Dragon of Lamentation', and the 'Drinking Demon', who had been fighting fierce battles nearby, also became noticeably sluggish.

"Ugh—"

And Snowfield and I, too, were slowly losing strength.

「The 'Third's' imagination has begun to threaten every element that interferes with 'Reality'.」

Snowfield said, glaring at me with a fierce look.

"Let go of my hand."

Snowfield was getting angry for the first time. I shook my head.

"No."

"Then."

A chill ran through Snowfield's eyes.

"This guy is going to die."

Snowfield's white hand gripped the Third Kim Dokja's head tightly. As the Third, who had been dreaming, frowned, the world that had been stabilizing began to shake once again. Snowfield was attempting to forcibly take the remaining fragment of the Third. The Third's soul, refusing to be absorbed, screamed.

I gripped the Third's hand tightly.

"Don't give up."

The legend I possessed flowed into the Third's hand. Subsequently, my story and Snowfield's legend clashed inside the Third.

「The One and Only Kim Dokja.」

A battle began over who would seize control of 'Kim Dokja'.

"You."

Snowfield's eyes widened as he confirmed my power. He seemed to have never imagined I would go this far. I grinned and said.

"If you want to absorb, try absorbing me too."

"Do you think I can't?"

As the stories of the absorbing side and the defending side clawed and tore apart each other's sentences, the Third's interior quickly became a battlefield. It seemed as though the Third's scream could be heard through the empty rift.

Ahhhhh.

But at this moment, there was no other way. Even the power of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was growing stronger in real time.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja must have gathered far more fragments than I have.」

During the eight years I was away, he collected countless 'Kim Dokja fragments' scattered across the world and climbed from the bottom of the scenario all the way to the very top. Facing such a guy with a sheer volume of pure 'Kim Dokja fragments' was overwhelming.

That wasn't all. Even if I could handle him, if he were to inject a stronger story into the Third here and force it upon him, the Third's soul would shatter into pieces.

「I had to buy time.」

I needed time for the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and Jung Heewon to defeat their opponents and come to my aid.

I took a deep breath and used the power of 「Revision」 that I had been saving within me. The accumulated probability was sucked out in an instant, and the landscape of the world began to turn upside down.

[Exclusive Skill, '□□', activated!]

The scenery turned into a monochrome landscape. Space-time began to slowly come to a halt.

「An ability I would normally have used merely to buy time to think.」

In this landscape, the space-time coordinates of every being are fixed. To be precise, that was the case for everyone except me.

Enduring the probability from behind, I moved slowly. I utilized the story, that possessed resistance to probability, to the extreme to defy the backlash, and slowly reached out to grab Snowfield's wrist. Then, I carefully removed his hand from the Third's head.

Probability had tightened its grip around my neck as punishment for violating the world's rules, but for now, this was the best option.

The very moment I removed his hand from the Third...

「Snowfield's eyes moved.」

I got goosebumps. Until now, in this colorless landscape—within the blanks of the sentences—only I could move. But Snowfield was looking at me.

"Yes, so this is that ability."

He was even speaking. I felt the balance of probability shift once again. Surprisingly, Snowfield was moving within this alternate dimension, exhibiting a resistance to probability as powerful as mine.

"Why are you so surprised? You weren't the only one capable of exerting power here."

The moment I heard him, something came to mind.

「He's right. There was one more person who could move within this 'landscape'.」

I shook my head.

"You aren't a 'writer'."

Nor did I sense the power of a 'recorder' from him.

"Right, it's not me."

Snowfield replied with a faint smile.

"Because I don't need to record myself."

That meant someone was recording Snowfield's actions on his behalf. A 'recorder' capable of moving him within this landscape while rejecting the influence of my skills.

I recalled the modifiers of several great recorders in my mind. But strangely enough, it didn't seem like they would be able to use such power.

Snowfield asked.

"■■-ah, you really don't know?"

An ominous thought ran through my mind.

Actually, I knew. A recorder who could move him within this landscape and stand against me.

There was only one such 'writer.' The most outstanding writer I knew, and my mentor.

"It doesn't matter."

I bit my lip tightly and threw a punch at him. In a movement as slow as a dream, my fist grazed his cheek.

Snowfield asked.

"So you want to fight?"

As if he had been waiting for this moment for a long time, Snowfield also extended his fist toward me. A fist as slow as mine. It was an attack that was impossible to miss—if I hadn't dodged it, I would have had no excuse even if I were scolded for three nights and four days by my transcendent masters.

Nevertheless, dodging that attack was not easy. Because my body was moving slowly, too.

"Ugh."

A fist that narrowly grazed my nose. I immediately grabbed his arm and attempted a throw. But for some reason, his body did not move.

Snowfield asked me, looking bewildered.

"Are you an idiot?"

Snowfield said, gripping my neck tightly from behind.

"There's no way a throw would work with our strength alone."

"I thought it would work because you're light."

Muttering curses under my breath, I barely managed to break free from his chokehold.

Since our bodies were sluggish, a crude battle of wits ensued. We tried desperately to trip each other, or waited for an opening to land a punch on each other's torsos.

"That kind of punch doesn't hurt."

"Who are you to say that?"

However, even if those cotton candy-like punches luckily landed on each other, they couldn't inflict a fatal wound.

Small cuts began piling up on our faces, and our stamina, rapidly depleted just as we had defied all logic, began to threaten us.

Gasping for breath, Snowfield and I threw punches at each other again and again. How long did we throw punches like that? After taking another blow each, we both knelt down almost simultaneously. It wasn't because it hurt. It was because we were exhausted.

Snowfield spoke.

"You've gotten quite strong."

I didn't think that was something to say while exchanging punches like cotton candy, but Snowfield was smiling at me. It was a smile that seemed to say he was proud of myself, or perhaps to record it.

"At first, you were a guy who couldn't even catch a single Ground Dog."

"Are you underestimating Ground Dogs? If you were in my shoes, you would have had a hard time too."

"Yeah. It is hard to catch them."

We looked at each other for a moment and chuckled. Come to think of it, we had both now become Kim Dokjas who had gone through the scenarios.

I asked.

"What were the scenarios like when you experienced it firsthand?"

"It wasn't easy."

"It looked easy when you were just watching, didn't it?"

"Honestly, it was."

It felt strange to be having this conversation with 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

He and I were both 49% Kim Dokjas.

We were Kim Dokjas born without going through the scenario, thanks to the sacrifice of 51%.

"There is no such thing as an easy story anywhere."

I entered the 41st round and experienced a scenario for the first time, and Snowfield, too, relinquished his position to enter the 41st round and carry out the scenario.

"Of course. There is no easy story."

We walked the path that 51% of Kim Dokja walked, each in our own way. And now we are here.

"Give up."

I said, looking at Snowfield.

"No matter how hard you try, we cannot harm each other here."

Instead of responding to my words, Snowfield looked around at the colorless landscape. A world where everything stood still. A landscape where the people who were fighting, and the stars that were watching us, had all come to a standstill. An unrecorded void.

In this colorless world, perhaps resembling his 'snowfield', Snowfield spoke with an infinitely serene face.

"I suppose so."

The moment I heard those words, I realized something belatedly.

「Snowfield knew my plan from the beginning.」

Nevertheless, Snowfield willingly went along with this story. Perhaps he knew all along.

「From now on, we must begin a truly terrifying story.」

The one and only Kim Dokja that remains.

The story that will determine the conclusion of the 41st round.

"■■-ah, you can't win."

"You won't know until you get to the end."

Snowfield shook his head and gazed somewhere. 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, now more than half gone, was fluttering there.

"There are things you can know without reading to the end."

That's right. Both he and I knew the ending of that story.

"No, there are stories we don't know even after reading to the end."

We were currently living a kind of side story. Living through a void not properly described in the main story, we were living a story where only the ending remained.

What was written was merely a trace of the ending of the 41st round. Neither the process leading to that ending nor its interpretation had been determined.

「Because no one has read this story properly yet.」

Snowfield's gaze turned sad as he looked at me.

"I've been watching you for a long time."

"Why?"

"Because I liked your story."

"And now?"

Snowfield didn't answer.

I paused for a moment before asking.

"Kim Dokja."

"Yes."

"Did you transmigrate me in this world?"

It was a question I had pondered for a very long time.

"Are you the one who threw me in the 41st round and made me carry out all these scenarios?"

At first, I thought it was Asmodeus's doing. However, as time passed, I came to realize that this miracle was not something Asmodeus could cause alone.

Furthermore, Asmodeus revealed that there were clearly beings participating in this plan besides himself. And as far as I knew, there were only a few multidimensional beings capable of wielding such a miracle.

Snowfield asked, wearing an enigmatic smile.

"If so?"

I looked up at the sky. The colorless landscape I had created was slowly crumbling. The power of the skill was running out.

Snowfield asked again.

"Do you resent me?"

If the me of the past had heard this question, I would have answered yes. I would have demanded to know why it had to be me, and why I was made to suffer such a tragedy.

I slowly lowered my head and gazed at Snowfield.

"Thank you."

Snowfield's eyes wavered faintly as he looked at me.

These were events I would never experience again. There was profound sorrow and terrible despair. Yet, having survived this world, there was a landscape I could see.

「Crossing all that time, I finally stand before the conclusion of this story.」

Tsutsutsu, the colorless landscape shattered. Taking advantage of Snowfield's momentary hesitation, I shoved his body hard. It was a strength of 1, but it was enough force to bring that limp body down. I climbed on top of him and assumed the pounding position. Even though the tide had completely turned in my favor, Snowfield remained calm.

"You can't beat me."

Snowfield said, and I nodded in response.

"Normally, that would be the case."

Surely, as of this moment, the amount of 'Kim Dokja fragments' he possesses must be greater than mine. Since he has wielded the power of 'Kim Dokja' for much longer than I have, his proficiency in handling that power is naturally higher than mine.

Nevertheless, I punched him straight into the chest. I felt the sentences written on the guy's chest sticking to my fist.

"If you are the 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' I remember, I would surely lose. But—"

I thought of the stars that had entered this world. I thought of Zeus, Poseidon, Demeter, and Odin.

「No myth-grade constellation has ever risked everything to 'go missing' here.」

Then what about 'Snowfield'?

"You didn't come here with 'all your stories', did you?"

At my words, Snowfield's eyes visibly wavered.

"You didn't go 'missing' completely like me, right?"

At first, I was unsure, but now I knew for sure. Perhaps it was a truth that only I, his brother, could sense.

「The 'Snowfield' standing before my eyes right now was not his true form.」

He relinquished his status from the heavens and descended to enter the world of scenarios. And from the very beginning, he cleared every scenario, rebuilding his own narrative anew.

Nevertheless, at this very moment of entering the world of the 'Third', he could not completely abandon his own narrative.

「Snowfield has found a precious story, too.」

I was bound to win this fight. The reason was simple.

"You left 'my story' out there, right?"

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 1000 Episode 60 Star Fragments (8)

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Snowfield gave no answer. I knew it even without him answering.

「Snowfield left the 'memory of reading my story' behind in the outside world.」

Just as myth-grade constellations left their true bodies outside, Snowfield also left his important memories behind to enter this place. And among those 'important memories', there exists a memory of me.

Snowfield slowly opened his mouth.

"I think you're mistaken. The reason I left those memories outside is because they are needed there."

At that remark, so typical of Kim Dokja, I didn't know what to say in response.

"And it's not just your memories that I left behind."

"…"

"If you've performed a scenario, you would know. That there is a story you don't want to lose, no matter what happens."

I was a little surprised by his honest words. I realized once again that Snowfield, standing before me, had also performed a scenario just like me. Over the past eight years, he must have built up his own story. And during those eight years, he had acquired a story he never wanted to lose.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', licks his lips.]

Suddenly, I became curious. I wanted to read that story. What kind of 'precious memory' could have formed in a boy raised by Cheon Inho's hands and grown up in the snowfield?

What is he envisioning through that story?

"In that sense, you are the truly strange one."

Snowfield muttered with a look of pity.

"You, who cherish people more than anyone, carelessly throw away the very self they love."

Snowfield is right. I, who chose to disappear into this world risking everything, might actually be the one much stranger than them.

"Still."

I pressed down on Snowfield's chest even harder and spoke. As if rebelling against my strength, Snowfield's story scratched my hand even more roughly.

"I won this time."

If he hadn't entered here in his main body, the absolute amount of 'Kim Dokja fragments' would inevitably be less than mine.

However, despite the crisis, Snowfield remained composed.

"There is one more thing you are mistaken about."

In an instant, a strange current flowed from Snowfield's entire body.

"Why do you think that just because I left my memories behind, I would have fewer fragments than you?"

In a split second, the flow of the air shifted. The massive amount of story flowing from him tightened its grip on me with an immense pressure.

「I had forgotten that he has already absorbed a significant amount of the Third Kim Dokja.」

I unleashed my story and confronted him head-on. It was different from when we faced each other with the Third's soul between us. His power, manifesting in its raw form, was pulling me in with tremendous force.

"Snowfield is trying to absorb me."

I, too, could not lose. I unleashed my story while pressing down on his chest.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', begins its storytelling!]

A small mouth that had grown from my palm began to devour the stories of Snowfield indiscriminately. However, Snowfield muttered as if he had anticipated even that.

"You cannot defeat me with just those stories."

The waves of story flowing from its entire body grew even stronger.

An overwhelming amount of story, powerful enough to momentarily cast out even the 'Heir to the Eternal Name' with his ruthless gluttony, surged toward me like a waterfall. Sentences that pierced me like needles instantly discolored my skin.

「Who is the 'Kim Dokja' that people truly want?」

「If it is not me, if no 'Kim Dokja fragment' is qualified to become the real Kim Dokja, then what on earth is 'Kim Dokja'?」

Snowfield's riddle pierced my mind. It felt as if my head was being covered in pure white sentences. Suppressing the urge to gag, I activated the [Fourth Wall] and desperately protected myself.

「I must use the power of a recorder.」

However, I was not certain what would happen to the world if I used my power any further here.

Is it right to destroy this world to protect myself? If so, what is the reason I came to this world?

The eyes of Snowfield were asking. Asking if I could do it. Asking if I could choose to absorb him, destroy this world, and become 'the one and only Kim Dokja'.

「Take me away.」

It was then that a voice reached my mind.

I suddenly looked up and saw the figure of a baby floating in the distance. It was the Third.

「I will help you.」

Almost simultaneously, Snowfield heard the Third's voice and shouted.

"White Flame Dragon of Lamentation! Drinking Demon!"

At Snowfield's command, the two constellations looked toward the Third Kim Dokja at the same time. But I was faster. Shaking off Snowfield's crests and rising from my seat, I ran with all my might and wrapped my arms around the Third. The blows of the White Flame Dragon and the Demon exploded on my back at the same time. Suppressing the burning pain, I held the Third even tighter.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', responds to the will of 'Third Kim Dokja'.]

I could feel the Third's soul resonating with me.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

Just as the 'Demon King of Salvation' and the 'Great King of Fear' had done, the soul of the 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage' was flowing into me.

「I wanted to keep living in this house.」

Hearing the Third's words whispering in my ears, I bit my lip hard.

「To keep living in this house with my brothers.」

That was the Third's true sentiment. A wish that might have come true had I and Snowfield never come to this world. Nevertheless, in exchange for that wish, the Third entrusted the dream he desired to me.

「I want to protect the 'house'.」

I thought about the landscape the Third wanted to protect. I imagined and imagined the house he had longed for so desperately.

「Someday, please—record that 'house'.」

My heart warmed gently, then subsided.

[A massive amount of 'loss' has been collected.]

[The 'loss' you collected will be recorded on the Final Wall.]

I felt an immense surge of vitality throughout my entire body.

「The probability given by the Third was swirling throughout my body.」

The power of 'Kim Dokja' who imagined this world. Snowfield and I, sharing that power, faced each other.

Snowfield slowly rose from his seat and spoke.

"Right, from now on, it's going to look like a fight."

We lunged at each other. Our fists, swung simultaneously, struck each other's faces. The punches that had felt like cotton candy now hurt. Even as we exchanged definite blows, we did not back down an inch. Amidst the punches, our lips split and our cheeks swelled.

Wiping away the flowing blood, Snowfield said.

"You are desperate."

"Of course."

"Why? You have no reason to do that."

Snowfield's punch landed in my stomach. I gasped and punched him in the jaw. Stumbling back, he spoke again.

"It wasn't a story you wanted to start in the first place. You are an outsider to this story. You are not Kim Dokja."

"My story, not even Kim Dokja's."

I grabbed the lunging guy by the collar and lifted him up. His body, which I couldn't lift before, now felt light.

Looking down at him as he slammed onto the floor, I asked.

"Why did you want to read it?"

Snowfield, pinned to the ground, pushed me away and stood up. As we exchanged punches again, both of us staggered at the same time. Snowfield answered.

"I don't know."

I could feel the sincerity in his answer. He truly did not have the answer to this question. I asked again.

"You used to hate the idea of me becoming Kim Dokja. Why, then, are you trying to become 'the one and only Kim Dokja' now?"

"Me too, I don't know."

Our fists, thrown simultaneously, struck each other's faces. We groaned in unison and recoiled.

「Some stories are completed in the form of absence.」

Every time Snowfield and my fists clashed, a story bloomed in the air.

Amidst the landscape of the blooming stories, Snowfield was watching a certain story. I couldn't see what story he was watching. However, his expression proved the existence of that story.

「Watching that story, Kim Dokja rejoiced or grieved. He got excited, sighed, and went wild.」

I paused for a moment.

「Watching that story, he wanted to become 'Kim Dokja'.」

In that record, I opened my mouth as if sighing.

"Could it be because of me?"

The reason why Snowfield, who had hated 'Kim Dokja' more than anyone, came to want to become 'the one and only Kim Dokja'.

"So, are you trying to gather <Kim Dokja Company>?"

As he watched my story, he dreamed once again. A dream of completing a scenario with the companions he desired. A dream of being chosen by the people he loved at the end of this world.

「Snowfield is dreaming once again that the <Kim Dokja Company> of those days will gather here and look at him.」

I shook my head and said.

"You know it, too. We are not the Kim Dokja that <Kim Dokja Company> wants."

In an instant, I felt spacetime creak. Snowfield was looking at me with a face I had never seen before.

"Then where is that 'Kim Dokja'?"

I couldn't answer.

What kind of Kim Dokja does <Kim Dokja Company> want? If all the Kim Dokjas really gather and become 'the one and only Kim Dokja' again, will the 'Kim Dokja' that <Kim Dokja Company> desires return?

"You don't know either."

The fist Snowfield threw at me along with those words hurt. I let out a sharp gasp and struck his face just as hard. A trickle of blood trickled from his nose.

"Right, I don't know either."

We both grew up reading and writing the story of 'Kim Dokja'. We have no memories of the time when we were the complete Kim Dokja. Most of our memories have disintegrated, and the stories of those days exist only as fragments of 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』. As we read and wrote those stories, we believed that we were Kim Dokja. We still believe.

"I don't know, but at least we aren't."

"You aren't the one deciding that."

Snowfield pointed to the sky and said.

"They are the ones who will be here soon."

Since when? The vortex in the sky was growing larger once again. The imagination of the 'Third' that Snowfield had absorbed was being unleashed. I spoke as if giving a warning.

"Your plan will fail. There is no way <Kim Dokja Company> would consider the current you as 'Kim Dokja'."

"Well. At least one of them."

Snowfield continued speaking without taking his eyes off the sky.

"They already believe me to be 'Kim Dokja'."

In that instant, I read the record flickering behind him.

「Kim Dokja gazed at the sky with sad eyes, as if counting distant stars.」

Why? The moment I read the sentence, I felt dizzy. There was a familiar scent emanating from the words.

「Thinking of the one person recording this world from beyond that sky, Kim Dokja was convinced.」

It was the scent of lemon candy. Recalling that nostalgic scent, I stared endlessly at the continuing sentence.

「Even if the whole world turns its back on him, only she will record him.」

The 41st round. And the 1,863rd round.

Memories of being with her swirled chaotically through my mind.

「Has she become a 'Recorder of Fear' as expected?」

If so, why has she never once spoken to me? Like the other great recorders, she would have had plenty of opportunities to talk to me.

And above all—

「Why is she recording the sentences of 'Snowfield' right now?」

Snowfield smiled as if answering my question.

"■■-ah, don't you still understand?"

With a face that seemed to already know the ending of this story, Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke to me.

"Han Sooyoung chose me as the 'protagonist' of this world."

Author's Note

As of today, Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint has reached Chapter 1,000—including short side stories—or Chapter 999 without them.

Seeing this unfamiliar number fills me with a renewed sense of emotion, yet also gives me a strange feeling.

Perhaps it is because today happens to be Sooyoung's birthday.

I sincerely thank the readers who have stayed with me through these long chapters.

I will do my best to write during the remaining time.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1001 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (1)

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「Is the person who understands the prison best the prisoner, or is it the person who created it?」

—Architect of the False Ending

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People were gathered in a pure white space resembling a snowfield. They were people who had guarded a single world for a very long time.

Watching people take their seats one by one, Yoo Sangah counted in her head. One, two, three... At some point, the numbers stopped going up. How high was the number originally supposed to go? Or, how high was the number capable of going?

Yoo Sangah could not remember.

"Everyone is here, Sangah-ssi."

At Lee Seolhwa's words, Yoo Sangah looked up. As she slowly looked around, she saw the faces of the people who had been nothing more than numbers in her head. They were people she could recognize no matter where they were in this universe.

「But their presence was definitely weaker than before.」

Deep shadows cast over their eyes. An indescribable weariness was etched on every face. It was the price for recklessly traversing worldlines and twisting the probability of other universes.

[The story, 'Kim Dokja Company', continues its storytelling.]

Watching this story continue despite everything, Yoo Sangah wondered. Where would the end of this story be?

"Unnie."

As she turned her head, the bravest girl she could remember spoke.

"Please make a decision quickly. I am ready to leave right now."

The time to call her a girl had passed. Nevertheless, Yoo Sangah clearly remembered the face of the girl who had slayed Specters in Chungmuro.

"The time to worry about probability has already passed."

Lee Jihye is now called the 'Monarch of the Great Sea'. She has become such a formidable incarnation that even those fearsome outer deities make way for her ghost fleet. It was not just Lee Jihye.

"We've come this far, so there is nothing to be afraid of. We don't have much time left anyway. And above all—"

The voice of a boy who had gone through puberty. The boy, now with a fairly masculine jawline, was speaking.

"I have entered that world."

Every time the boy spoke, a hallucinatory sound of a swarm of insects crying could be heard from somewhere. It was likely the Demon God 'Abaddon's'.

The will of the ancient Demon God, who still protected the boy, was responding to his courage.

"I am confident I can enter it again and again."

Lee Gilyoung had already nearly died once in the 41st round. Falling into Asmodeus's scheme, he almost lost his life on a manipulated stage. Nevertheless, Lee Gilyoung said he would make the same choice once again.

Yoo Sangah, and everyone else present, knew why Lee Gilyoung was acting so strongly.

"We have to find Shin Yoosung."

"…"

"The signal keeps weakening. You know what will happen if we delay any longer, don't you, noona?"

The other members of <Kim Dokja Company> also seemed to agree. They had already lost precious comrades several times over. And if they delayed any longer here, they might lose another comrade.

"Right now—"

The moment Lee Gilyoung sprang to his feet, an intense ringing in the white space echoed. A ringing that seemed to come from a very distant place. It sounded like a baby crying, or perhaps someone muttering.

"Did you just hear that?"

As Lee Gilyoung spoke, the other members of <Kim Dokja Company> nodded as well.

"Something is calling us."

Lee Seolhwa activated the central control unit as she spoke. Then, the coordinates of the location from which the crying came appeared on the large screen.

Lee Jihye asked.

"Which way is it? 'The 41st round'?"

"It's not the '41st round'. It is true that you can enter via that round, but..."

The crying was heard once again. This time, it was clearer. Listening closely, it wasn't crying, but a story.

「...Surviving in a ruined world…」

Long, echoing sentences. At that moment, everyone at <Kim Dokja Company> realized.

「...There are three ways…」

Just what kind of being was calling them from beyond.

「As if entranced, everyone there gazed in the same direction.」

Lee Gilyoung asked in a trembling voice.

"Can we go there?"

Lee Seolhwa nodded. The next moment, a shimmering portal appeared next to the central control unit.

Tsutsutsutsu.

A passageway where the aftershocks of probability were raging. Passing through that passage would lead to where the story had come from.

Lee Seolhwa spoke again.

"But safety..."

"I told you. The time for nitpicking about such things has passed."

The moment Lee Gilyoung walked toward the portal without hesitation, a large hand grabbed the boy's shoulder.

"Stop."

Lee Gilyoung turned around, his expression contorted. It was Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You must not go."

A low but heavy voice. Just as Lee Gilyoung was about to speak again in defiance, Yoo Joonghyuk added.

"I'll go."

"How long are you going to act as you please—"

Lee Gilyoung stopped speaking there and fell silent. He realized he had no right to say such things to Yoo Joonghyuk.

Come to think of it, it was actually he who had acted selfishly. It was none other than Yoo Joonghyuk who had indulged his childishness when he jumped into the 41st round

just to see Kim Dokja.

"Let's go together."

At Lee Gilyoung's words, Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes wavered slightly. Lee Gilyoung continued.

"I said let's go together. You haven't fully recovered yet, either."

A long, pitch-black scar remained on Yoo Joonghyuk's neck, the result of the fierce battle with Odin.

Lee Jihye stepped forward and spoke.

"Um, I don't know if I'm mistaken, but..."

It was a voice mixed with surprise, bewilderment, and a hint of anticipation.

"I can feel the power of Hyunsung ahjussi and Heewon unnie over there."

At Lee Jihye's words, the others in the group also heightened their senses to verify the story. Lee Seolhwa nodded and said,

"That's right. The two of them are being confirmed inside there, too. And the Great Sage Heaven's Equal—"

"Shin Yoosung is there too!"

If everything being confirmed now is true, then beyond that portal, the entire <Kim Dokja Company> they knew might be gathering.

And above all.

「The 'Kim Dokja' they knew might be there.」

Everyone here felt a gravitational pull stronger than ever before. Every story of Kim Dokja's life was vividly conveyed across the vast universe.

The Demon King of Salvation. The Watcher of Light and Darkness. The Prisoner of the Golden Cage. And the Oldest Dream.

All the names Kim Dokja had lived by were swirling beyond that portal, calling out to them.

Yoo Joonghyuk gazed at the portal for a moment before speaking.

"Make your decision."

Everyone looked at Yoo Sangah. Receiving the gazes of the group, Yoo Sangah quietly closed her eyes.

「Perhaps the time has come to confirm the final chapter of this journey.」

What if Han Sooyoung had been here? What would she have said? For the sake of the group, what final sentence would she have left behind?

Yoo Sangah could not know. Because she was not a writer. She was merely a friend to the readers. Someone who listens to the readers' impressions and listens to their words. Someone who converses with the readers.

But here, there were neither readers nor writers. What was here now was—

[The 'Recorder of Fear', who has signed a 'Record Contract' with you, is calling you.]

A summoning message flickered in the air. Yoo Sangah immediately checked the sender of the message. It was a Recorder she knew well.

"Sangah-ssi?"

As Yoo Sangah's silence grew longer, Lee Seolhwa called out to her with an anxious expression. However, Yoo Sangah remained silent for quite some time. She simply read the record before her eyes over and over again. How much time had passed like that? A determination flickered in Yoo Sangah's eyes.

"Let's go."

---

「Soon, 'the one and only Kim Dokja' will be completed.」

I was confused. Was Han Sooyoung really writing all these sentences?

Blocking Snowfield's punch, I thought about Han Sooyoung. I had no idea why she was participating in the 'Record' of this worldline, or why she didn't say a word to me.

However, if it was certain that she had indeed intervened in the story as a 'Recorder'—

「The probability of <Kim Dokja Company> gathering here increases.」

Snowfield smiled white.

"You look like you don't understand. Why I am benefiting from the 'Record'."

That's right. I didn't understand. But on the other hand, I understood better than anyone.

「The 'Snowfield' before my eyes was closer to the archetype of '49% Kim Dokja' than anyone else.」

The last Han Sooyoung I saw carried a heavy sense of guilt toward Kim Dokja.

「She is someone who has written stories solely to save one person.」

If that record is meant to save 'Kim Dokja,' she will write it over and over again.

I calmed my mind with a light deep breath and opened my mouth.

"Aren't you being too overconfident? Just because Han Sooyoung is recording you doesn't guarantee she's on your side."

"What?"

"Think about it. Has the protagonist of any of her novels ever been happy, even once?"

Snowfield frowned slightly.

"This time it will be different."

"Yeah, I hope so too."

"..."

"If the story ends with another sad conclusion, I think it would be really hard on my heart, too."

A light breeze brushed between us, and Snowfield lowered the fist he had raised. Then, he spoke in the calm and quiet voice I knew.

"Then let's stop here. You've done enough."

Snowfield's Kim Dokja, who had no choice but to leave 'my story' outside because he loved it. Even though I had left that story behind, his expression remained warm. For a moment, I felt a desire to entrust all my fragments to him and become a single Kim

Dokja. I simply wanted to be at ease. It was a temptation I might have succumbed to in the past.

"Not yet."

Nevertheless, I could not stop here.

[All your stories respond to your will.]

The history I had lived through was sustaining me.

Snowfield looked into my story and asked.

"What is the reason you want to become 'the one and only Kim Dokja' to such an extent?"

The reason I want to become the one and only Kim Dokja.

"If you have read my story so far, you should know."

"I want to hear it directly from your own mouth."

"I want to set everything right."

Once I uttered those words myself, I felt my goal become somehow much clearer.

Wiping my blood-stained lips and catching my breath, I continued speaking.

"I want to create an ending where no one becomes unhappy."

Snowfield shook his head.

"That's impossible. You know that, too. That isn't a proper 'story'."

Snowfield looked up at the night sky. Since the constellations could not see this world, not all the starlight floating in the night sky belonged to the constellations.

"No star wants a story like that."

I know now what kind of beings the stars are. Beings who endlessly cheer for someone, yet in reality observe their tragedy. Beings who crave someone's survival while feeling intense ecstasy at their death. Beings who want the ending of this story more than anyone, yet in reality want the story to continue.

「There is no ending that can satisfy all those stars.」

"The ending you dream of won't convince anyone."

"..."

"So just admit it. You aren't Kim Dokja."

Saying that I am not Kim Dokja. Perhaps it was an easy thing to do. Nevertheless, I said this.

"We aren't the ones deciding that."

As if he hadn't expected to receive those words back, Snowfield opened his eyes wide.

"Yes, that's true."

We looked at each other for a moment. Our faces covered in blood. We resembled one another, as if facing a mirror.

「It won't be easy for anyone to figure out which of us is the real Kim Dokja.」

Snowfield opened his mouth with a faint smile.

"Then, let's call the person who can decide that."

"What?"

At the same time as my question, the air split open. What emerged from the rift was a small girl. She collapsed forward, appearing to be unconscious.

「'Beast Lord'— Shin Yoosung.」

From a distance, the mournful cry of a 'Chimera Dragon' could be heard.

Judging by the power of the story flowing out, she was undoubtedly Shin Yoosung of <Kim Dokja Company>. Just as Dansu ahjussi had said, she had been in this world with us.

"That child will surely figure out which of us is the 'real Kim Dokja'."

I saw Shin Yoosung slowly open her eyes with a small groan. The story inside me was humming and reacting to her. It was the same for Snowfield. The history of 'Kim Dokja' that we possessed was calling out to her.

「She is the incarnation of 'Kim Dokja'.」

I realized it instinctively. The events about to unfold were the 'final probability' that would shape the conclusion of this world.

「The being chosen by that girl will become the 'only Kim Dokja' of this world.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1002 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (2)

Was she injured while wandering through worldlines? Shin Yoosung's hands were covered in scars.

「Like a travel souvenir that has been aging poignantly while left neglected in a warehouse for a long time.」

Some records make us see the world through the form of those records. Is that why? The moment I read Han Sooyoung's sentence, I choked up and my emotions poured out without me realizing it.

"Yoo..."

But in the end, I could not bring myself to call out Shin Yoosung's name. It was due to an inexplicable sense of unease.

「That Shin Yoosung was definitely the Shin Yoosung of <Kim Dokja Company>.」

No matter how differently time flows across worldlines, quite a lot of time has passed since Kim Dokja disappeared in the 1,864th round.

Yet why does she still look like a young girl?

「The girl raised her head and stared blankly at me.」

At that moment, I realized why she still looked like a young girl.

「That appearance is the 'Shin Yoosung' that Kim Dokja remembers.」

Perhaps she hoped that the Kim Dokja she met again would recognize her immediately. Was that why she traveled the world in the form of a child, minimizing the consumption of probability?

「Her name is Shin Yoosung. Kim Dokja's only incarnation.」

I opened my mouth with the feeling of opening an old warehouse door. This time, I felt I could call her name accurately. I felt I could call Shin Yoosung with the emotions I had longed for, and with the heart of Kim Dokja she had hoped for.

But someone called her name even faster than I did.

"Yoosoung-ah."

It was Snowfield.

"Do you recognize me?"

Shin Yoosung's eyes slowly widened as she saw Snowfield.

「The Kim Dokja she remembered was there.」

Shin Yoosung rose from her seat and began walking toward Snowfield, one step at a time. I felt I had to stop her. I hurriedly grabbed Snowfield by the collar.

"What did you do to Yoosoung?"

Snowfield looked at me, his body trembling listlessly.

"Where on earth and for how long did you leave her to end up in this state?"

Snowfield looked at me for a moment, then asked back in a low voice.

"What do you think I would have done?"

I was speechless for a moment. Snowfield spoke.

"She is no longer a child."

"It doesn't matter whether she is a child or not. You—"

I was about to say that he was unfit to be Kim Dokja. But the moment I saw Snowfield's expression, followed by Shin Yoosung looking at us, the words I was about to say lost their power and scattered like dust.

「What is the qualification of Kim Dokja?」

Is the Kim Dokja who treats Shin Yoosung well the proper Kim Dokja? Is the Kim Dokja who possesses the stories that Shin Yoosung remembers the true Kim Dokja?

Or is it—

"Ahjussi...?"

The sky was resonating with the stories Shin Yoosung was emitting.

Woooooh!

The sorrowful roar of the Chimera Dragon echoed.

[The story, 'Kim Dokja Company', continues its storytelling.]

Snowfield shook off my hand that had been grabbing his collar and opened his arms toward Shin Yoosung.

"Yoosoung-ah."

I stared blankly at his retreating figure.

Snowfield's Kim Dokja, opening his arms toward Shin Yoosung, looked just like the Kim Dokja from my memories. Even though I knew he wasn't that Kim Dokja, and even though I knew he originated from the same 49% of Kim Dokja as me—

「Even I, at least for that moment, wanted to believe that he was the 'real Kim Dokja'.」

This was the power of stories. The power to make existence more like existence, and ultimately to persuade even other beings.

Simply because he possessed the most 'Kim Dokja fragments' in this world, he was the Kim Dokja closest to the real Kim Dokja than anyone else here right now.

「Perhaps it is fitting that he becomes 'the one and only Kim Dokja'.」

Unlike me, who has lived forgetting the fact that I am 'Kim Dokja', he has lived his entire life to reclaim that position.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates strongly!]

Therefore, isn't it only right for him to sit on Kim Dokja's throne now?

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', frowns at your weakness.]

Finally, Shin Yoosung entered Snowfield's embrace. She was trembling softly, like a small bird that had barely managed to land in its parents' arms.

"Ahjussi."

Holding the small girl tightly in his arms, Snowfield whispered.

"Yes, it is time for everyone to gather now."

A dazzling beam of light emanated from Snowfield's entire body, having been chosen by Shin Yoosung.

I gazed at the scene alone. Within the story, where I could not intervene, a world was being completed. It was then that my eyes met Shin Yoosung's.

"Ah."

Tears welled up in Shin Yoosung's eyes as she looked at me over the snowy slope. The child's small lips parted.

「Rumble struck ceaselessly from the sky. Beyond the swirling sky, the 'Big House' was approaching.」

But I was powerless in the face of the pouring records.

Han Sooyoung, is this the ending you truly wanted? Did you leave me behind in this world just to complete this story?

「That can't be right.」

My head throbbed for a moment. When I staggered and turned around, someone was holding my shoulder.

"Friend."

It was Dansu ahjussi.

"Are you really going to end it like this?"

Dansu ahjussi continued speaking to me, who was unable to utter a single word.

"The friend I know is not someone who would end the story here."

The story of our friendship that he remembered was being conveyed through his fingertips.

"At Geumho Station, my friend saved me while dying. And he cleared the scenario in a way no one had ever imagined."

「"Ahjussi, please make sure you live until the very end."」

[Story fragment, 'Instigator Killer', begins its storytelling.]

Along with a poignant sensation, Dansu ahjussi's emotions were conveyed intact. Dansu ahjussi remembered that story, which was so old, without forgetting a single word.

[Story fragment, 'King Maker', begins its storytelling.]

"If it hadn't been for my friend at Gwanghwamun, I would have died. I would have been consumed by madness, turned into a monster, harmed people, and died."

「"Ahjussi, don't worry. I will be with you."」

I, too, remembered the events of that day. I could still vividly recall the moment when, through [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], I achieved the title of 'King of Immortality' together with ahjussi.

"It was the same at the Twelve Zodiac Ball. Even when we had all lost our masks and given up, exhausted by the scenario—"

「"There is a way."」

[Story fragment, 'Liberator of the Recycling Center', begins its storytelling.]

"My friend found a way. He somehow found the ending that others had given up on and showed it to us. He showed us that such an ending is possible."

The time we spent together at Geumho Station, at Gwanghwamun, and at the Recycling Center—the story we shared—was there.

"That isn't the ending my friend wants to see, is it?"

I slowly came to my senses, as if I had been doused with cold water.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', submits to the will of incarnation 'Lee Dansu'.]

The story of Kim Dokja stirring within me—my ego was speaking.

「When the heavens open and <Kim Dokja Company> arrives, this world will shatter just as it is.」

The Third's 'Big House', unable to withstand the story's gravitational pull, will disappear. <Kim Dokja Company> will be swept away by the massive story created by Snowfield.

「Having absorbed it, 'Snowfield' will reclaim the status of the 'Oldest Dream'.」

As a result, <Kim Dokja Company> might all end up gathered in Snowfield's house.

With everything broken down, they might be able to live in the 'Big House' that 49% of Kim Dokja wanted to recreate.

「But is it really okay for this universe to be completed in that way?」

Is that truly the dream of the 'Demon King of Salvation', the 'Great King of Fear', the 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage', and me?

"Lee Dansu."

Emitting a dazzling light, Snowfield warned.

"Step back. If you do that, you won't get what you want."

Snowfield clearly understood what Dansu ahjussi was trying to do.

"You wanted to get your daughter back, didn't you?"

Getting your daughter back.

Incarnation Lee Dansu has lived his entire life solely for that one purpose.

"You will be able to meet Jiyoon again soon. We are almost there. You can return to the world you have dreamed of."

It was an irresistible temptation. I would have felt the same way if I were him. Returning to the world where he lived with his daughter. That was the very life he had desperately longed for. If that was the price Snowfield offered, then his helping him all this time was entirely understandable.

However, what I could not understand was this:

"In the world you dream of."

Why is incarnation 'Lee Dansu' standing by my side with the ending he desires right before his eyes?

"Do I have a 'friend'?"

For a moment, I did not understand what he was talking about. Snowfield also frowned. He glanced lightly at me and asked.

"Why is that important? There is no reason for that to be included in your daily life."

At that, Dansu ahjussi shook his head slowly and firmly.

"My daily life right now is here."

He looked at me with his characteristic kind gaze and turned to look at the constellations desperately struggling against each other.

"This world, where I have friends and constellations, is my daily life. This world, where Heewon-ssi, Hyunsung-ssi, and Wukong-ssi exist, is my daily life."

"You're insane."

Snowfield retorted in a cold voice.

"Snap out of it, Noh Kyunghwan."

Noh Kyunghwan. Snowfield, too, knew Dansu ahjussi's real name. That meant he must know how ahjussi ended up here.

"Have you already forgotten? That you lost everything because of 'Kim Dokja'."

On the day ahjussi became the 'King of Immortality', I, too, witnessed his history. I still remembered it.

「On that day, when countless 'Kim Dokja fragments' split into the universe, Noh Kyunghwan lost everything.」

If Kim Dokja hadn't scattered across the entire universe that day, his wife would not have been killed by the meteorite. He and his daughter would not have possessed this world. Nor would his daughter's soul have been subjugated to Asmodeus's Theater.

「Ahjussi would not have had to bear all this tragedy.」

Nevertheless, the man who had endured all that tragedy stood before my eyes now.

"Could all these events really be the fault of just one person?"

I dared not know how much time it must have taken for him to say those words. The man, who still looked at the world with kind eyes even after swallowing all those terrible stories, looked at me.

"Do not blame yourself, friend. You did not do anything wrong. Every story you pursued was not wrong."

To whom was he speaking?

I could not even dare to fathom what was on his mind as he told me that.

I saw Snowfield, frowning, whispering something to Shin Yoosung. The size of the portal swirling in the air was rapidly expanding.

「The 'Big House' begins.」

Shin Yoosung's story, interwoven with Snowfield's story, was calling for a different <Kim Dokja Company>.

「The 'Stage' will open.」

Even in the face of the world's collapse, Dansu ahjussi remained calm. Like Kim Dokja, who says there is still a way, he was looking at me with eyes that were more like Kim Dokja than any Kim Dokja I knew.

"I haven't been able to finish reading the novel my daughter likes. So, to be honest, I don't really know what kind of 'Kim Dokja' <Kim Dokja Company> wants."

Dansu ahjussi's hand resting on my shoulder was endlessly warm. Through that warmth, something was being conveyed to me.

"But the 'Kim Dokja' they want isn't the only 'Kim Dokja,' is it?"

Only then did I realize what Dansu ahjussi was planning to do.

There was only one reason why Shin Yoosung was moved by Snowfield. It was because the 'Snowfield' right before my eyes—possessed the 'most' 'Kim Dokja fragments' in this alternate dimension.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', opens its mouth as if it had been waiting.]

And damn it, there was still a 'large Kim Dokja fragment' remaining in this world that I hadn't absorbed.

"The 'Kim Dokja' I know is also definitely 'Kim Dokja'."

Dansu ahjussi's story was being conveyed to me. Everything about the 'Kim Dokja' he had built up flowed into me.

"The person who saved me and the person who made me alive so far are all 'Kim Dokja' that I know."

The world reflected in ahjussi's eyes was quietly scattering away amidst the rays of light.

"I hope my 'Kim Dokja' survives until the very end of this world."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1003 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (3)

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I had to do something. I couldn't let Dansu ahjussi be lost like this.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', frowns at your hypocrisy.]

My story was looking at me.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', asks if you shouldn't accept him anyway.]

The story was right. To defeat Snowfield, I, too, could not turn a blind eye to everything forever. I clearly need Dansu ahjussi's power. But.

「At the very least, the development shouldn't be like this.」

I grabbed Dansu ahjussi's hand.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint', activated!]

I felt as if space-time were distorting. All the stories, traits, and skills within me overlapped and swirled violently.

[Exclusive Trait, 'Record Repairer', activated!]

What I needed right now was just a fleeting moment of space.

[Exclusive skill, '□□', activated!]

When I opened my eyes again, I was standing in an unfamiliar place. No, perhaps it wasn't an unfamiliar place. Because I knew where this was.

A stage where old lights flickered. Amidst the flickering strange lights, I saw the back of Dansu ahjussi not far away.

"Ahjussi."

"Friend."

Ahjussi turned to me with a welcoming smile, then looked around and spoke.

"It's fascinating. Is this a space my friend created?"

"No, this isn't it."

"Ah."

Dansu ahjussi let out a low sigh, as if realizing something just then.

"I see."

I stood side by side with Dansu ahjussi and looked around.

"Does my friend remember that, too?"

"Yes."

We were standing in a flower garden. However, it was not a simply beautiful scene. 'Red Spider Lilies of Death' were scattering in the wind.

This was a flower garden that bloomed from the breath of a Grade 5 Disaster Species.

"You saved me when I was on the verge of death here."

I, too, remembered this place well.

「It was here that Dansu ahjussi became the 'Immortal King'.」

The only difference from then was that Dansu ahjussi's stories were scattering like dust under every petal of the red spider lilies blooming on the ground.

「This was 'Dansu ahjussi's' inner world.」

The blank space, barely stopped by the power of skill [□□], was where Dansu ahjussi's stories were scattering.

As I reached out my hand toward the empty space, a few petals wrapped around my fingertips and soon began to whisper their own story.

The first thing I saw was the figure of a woman. Dansu ahjussi looked into the woman's face beside me and said,

"She is my wife."

Ahjussi's wife, who was said to have passed away hit by a meteor, was a very beautiful person.

"She was someone who shouldn't have left like that."

I could feel his memories as if I had become ahjussi himself.

The day he first met his wife, the day he proposed to her, the day they promised a lifetime together and built a simple family.

His personal memories were scattering before me like lush flower petals.

"It's Jiyoon."

At the tip of the petal ahjussi pointed to, young Jiyoon was crying.

「"Abba."」

A child whose speech was as hesitant as Biyoo. A girl smiling shyly with her mouth smeared with tomato sauce.

"She's caused me so much trouble since she was little."

Listening to ahjussi's low laughter, I silently read and reread his entire history.

"That must be when you first saw that story."

The Dansu ahjussi in my memory was reading a book on his smartphone.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

The story Jiyoon loved.

In order to get close to his daughter, ahjussi searched the Internet for unfamiliar terms and read the book diligently.

| |
|---|
| Number of completed books: 1 |

Ahjussi told me he hadn't finished reading the novel. But I know. He had read the whole book. And he read that one time more diligently than anyone else. He read it truly hard to understand his only daughter.

"It was a story too difficult for me to understand. That is why I said I couldn't read it properly."

Saying that, ahjussi smiled bitterly.

"It wasn't just that story that was difficult, though."

The last flower petal held our story within it.

'Geumho Station' with ahjussi. The Star Gem Dungeon of 'Gwanghwamun'. The 'Recycling Center'. And all the way to this world beyond the 'Missing Bush'.

Watching the flowing story, ahjussi said:

"My friend must hate me."

"Why do you think that?"

"Because I couldn't trust my friend and wait for him."

Ahjussi wore a look of regret regarding his deal with Snowfield.

I spoke as if to comfort him:

"You had no choice. If I were you, I would have done the same."

Ahjussi smiled weakly. The speed at which the scattering petals shattered was gradually increasing. In the distance, I could see the space covered in spider lilies slowly shrinking. I urgently grabbed ahjussi's wrist.

「Then, ahjussi’s wrist shattered.」

Dansu ahjussi's soul was already on the verge of collapse.

「His eyes were blind, and parts of his body were necrotic. The muscles in his limbs had fallen off in chunks.」

The man, who had become the 'King of Immortality', had lived with such a soul for a very long time.

「Having lost his wife, his daughter, and even his comrades.」

I bit my lip tightly.

Hasn't he lived a life deserving of reward more than anyone else in this world?

Is the ending I am pursuing valuable enough to justify sacrificing his entire history?

"You don't have to help me."

There is no such thing as an ending where sacrificing anyone is worthwhile.

"You have done enough, ahjussi. You can go to Snowfield. You may accept what he promised you."

The moment I saw the look on his face, I realized it. A person who distorts everything into good intentions and embraces everything with broad tolerance. Such a person does not exist.

"Just because I saved you doesn't mean you need to sacrifice yourself. You—"

There is only someone who, even amidst tragedy, desperately strives and struggles to avoid turning a blind eye to the world's small acts of kindness and to preserve his humanity.

"Friend, don't get the wrong idea."

At that moment, for the first time, ahjussi's tone resembled Kim Dokja.

"I didn't choose you simply because I like you."

"Huh?"

Dansu ahjussi said, looking up somewhere with a hazy expression.

"Couldn't you dream the same dream that he can dream?"

A landscape I didn't even know myself flashed through ahjussi's now-blinded eyes.

"I only made a selfish choice for myself and my daughter. I only wish for a happier ending, hoping that you become Kim Dokja."

Watching ahjussi speak like that, I didn't know what to say. But I had to say something.

"I."

I thought of ahjussi's daughter. Noh Jiyoon. rlaehrwk37. I thought of my reader, who might still be watching this story from the Theater of Asmodeus.

"Can you really do it?"

"I will make sure you and Jiyoon meet."

I had to say that. But strangely, no voice came out until the very end.

Ahjussi just smiled quietly, as if to say it was okay if I didn't say anything.

"I like my friend's story."

"…"

"I wanted to hear more of my friend's story. I was always curious about what kind of person he was and what he liked."

If we had met somewhere other than this world, would we have been able to share more stories? As a writer and a reader. As a reader and a reader. Or as a friend. Just as one person to another.

"My name is Noh Kyunghwan."

"I know."

"What is my friend's name? I definitely heard it before, but strangely, I can't remember it."

I tried to tell him my name. But I, too, could not know my own name.

■■■.

Perhaps it is because that name—that story—is not mine now.

Dansu ahjussi added in a heavy tone, as if he understood all these facts.

"Once you become 'the one and only Kim Dokja', what happens to my friend? Can my friend return to being my original friend?"

I could not answer.

Dansu ahjussi stared at me silently and added.

"I am sorry for entrusting so many stories to my friend."

Now, more than half of his soul was shattered. There was little space left for us. Through the scattering petals, I thought I heard Jiyoon's voice calling for her father for a moment.

"Even after reading that book, I still don't really know who Kim Dokja is. However, I do know a little bit about the kind of person the 'Kim Dokja' my daughter liked was."

Stories are passed from books to people, and from people to people. It is the story that plunges us into tragedy, but it is also the story that ultimately lifts us up from this tragedy.

Dansu ahjussi extended his one remaining hand to me. I slowly took that hand. Dansu ahjussi, who had entrusted me with all his stories and his 'Kim Dokja'—a man named Noh Kyunghwan was speaking to me.

"My friend will surely become a 'good Kim Dokja'."

With a face kinder than any Kim Dokja I knew.

"I will watch over my friend's story."

---

Snowfield gazed at his brother, enveloped in a beam of light. Lee Dansu had not kept his promise. He had ultimately chosen to be absorbed by his brother as a 'Kim Dokja Fragment'.

「Snowfield understood Lee Dansu's choice.」

Perhaps all stories were destined to unfold that way. Now, it didn't matter. After all, he had achieved his goal. Even if his brother were to wake up again, he could not stop what

was already happening.

Gooooo!

A pitch-black figure was about to reveal itself from the sky, which was more than half open. The moment he had long awaited was arriving.

A long-held dream. The moment when all of <Kim Dokja Company> would gather.

Shin Yoosung, held in his arms, was trembling slightly. Holding the girl's small body, Snowfield gazed endlessly up at the sky.

「The stage that every Kim Dokja has dreamed of is about to begin.」

And the next moment.

"Stop."

A voice as cold as if the world were freezing was heard. Snowfield frowned and turned his head.

His brother was speaking with his hand on his shoulder.

"At least not here."

The powerful force of [Incite] rippled over his voice. The power of the villain who had once raised him, capable of overturning the laws of the world.

"Because those people deserve a happy ending."

Snowfield straightened his back and glared at his brother.

"By what right do you say such things?"

Then ■■■ looked at Snowfield.

The one who had lost his name was speaking his own name.

"Because I am Kim Dokja."

There stood Kim Dokja, who had finally fully accepted that fact. Kim Dokja, who had come to terms with the stories embedded in that name and all the karma. Kim Dokja, who

had clearly accepted the life he was to live, and that world of distant eternity and finality.

Thus, Snowfield realized.

「Now, his brother has become a 'Kim Dokja' just like him.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1004 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (4)

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Snowfield felt a complex mix of emotions as he watched his brother.

「If he had retained his complete memories, would I have felt different emotions?」

His original body had not granted him some of his core memories. Consequently, Snowfield's feelings of love and hate toward the brother before him were somewhat faint. He had a sense that he liked his story, but he did not know exactly how much he liked it, or for what purpose his original body had been watching over him.

If he had been the complete 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

Would he have been happy that his brother had become a full-fledged 'Kim Dokja', or would he have been sad that he, too, had come to walk the same path as him?

He could not know. All Snowfield could know was his immediate emotions. An inexplicable hostility surging deep within his heart.

「Actually, perhaps he was glad that his brother wasn't a 'proper Kim Dokja'.」

That he was the one who would become the 'sole Kim Dokja' during the 'Kim Dokja Dismissal'—that only he was qualified to complete the story here. Perhaps he had unwittingly believed that all along.

"Yes, you have become Kim Dokja."

Now, clearly standing before his eyes was a 'different Kim Dokja'. Along with him, 'The Undoubted Kim Dokja', who was qualified to imagine the end of this world:

"But it's too late."

As Snowfield beckoned, the 'White Flame Dragon of Lamentation' and the 'Drinking Demon' rushed in upon receiving the signal.

Most of the constellations, including Zeus and Poseidon, were already incapacitated. There was no one to stop the White Flame Dragon and the Demon.

"Dodge!"

With Poseidon's shout, the long sword drawn by the White Flame Dragon flew toward his brother. The brother's cold eyes stared at the White Dragon. For a moment, the White Flame Dragon's pupils widened, but the sword pierced straight through the brother's chest.

Thud.

Kim Dokja was not a being specialized in 'physical ability' to begin with. No matter how much the total amount of fragments increased from absorbing Lee Dansu, there was no way he could withstand the White Flame Dragon's attack.

"Ah— No!"

Demeter collapsed with a scream, and the constellations knelt with faces of despair.

The 'White Flame Dragon of Lamentation' who actually stabbed him as expected wore a somewhat bewildered expression.

Snowfield did not take his eyes off the collapsing incarnation of his brother. They were clearly wounds that would lead to death. Yet, why did he sense no fear in his brother's face?

The reason became clear immediately.

[Exclusive Trait, 'Immortal King', effect activated!]

With a dazzling beam of light, the dead brother's body split open, and a new body was being born.

「The trait of incarnation Lee Dansu, 'Immortal King'.」

His brother, having inherited that trait intact, was rising from the dead again.

"Kill him again."

Snowfield commanded once more in an indifferent voice. This time, the 'Drinking Demon' lunged forward. However, the moment the brother's gaze fixed on the demon, its steps came to a halt. The demon wore an expression as if it had witnessed something it could not handle.

"White Flame Dragon."

The White Flame Dragon was just as disobedient. Witnessing the resurrection unfolding before his eyes in real time, his entire body trembled like an aspen tree.

His brother spoke.

"Get out of the way. This is not a place for you to interfere."

'Resurrection' in this world was a miracle on a completely different level from 'Resurrection' in the <Star Stream>.

「Nevertheless, his brother has gained enough probability to exercise that 'power'.」

Snowfield, clenching his fist stealthily, gave the command once again.

"Strike. What are you doing?"

Even at Snowfield's command, the 'Drinking Demon' and the 'Sighing White Flame Dragon' did not move. It was because his brother had also given them orders.

"Watch from there."

At the [Incite] embedded in the voice, the stars froze like statues. It was proof that the power possessed by his brother had now become just as strong.

Nevertheless, Snowfield did not panic. He had already been chosen by Shin Yoosung. The record is progressing, and the stage is opening. Therefore…

"…Ahjussi?"

Since when did his embrace feel so empty? And since when did the girl let go of his hand and start walking away?

「A few steps away, Shin Yoosung was approaching his brother.」

Eyes slowly widening, Shin Yoosung spoke again in a trembling voice.

"Ahjussi… Right?"

His brother looked down at Shin Yoosung with silent, sad eyes. Shin Yoosung's gaze was filled with confusion. She staggered, glancing alternately at the two Kim Dokjas.

"Why, ahjussi—"

Snowfield remained silent. According to his plan, Shin Yoosung should have been intoxicated by his story right now. However, Shin Yoosung had come to her senses and realized that 'two Kim Dokjas' existed in this world.

The implications of that fact were clear.

「Perhaps now his brother possesses 'more fragments of Kim Dokja' than Snowfield himself.」

As if seeing right through Snowfield's heart, his brother spoke with sad eyes.

"That's enough."

Snowfield shook his head.

Thunder struck beyond the brightened sky. Giant shadows rippled beyond the swirling portal.

"It's too late. The heavens have already opened."

Possessions of awe comparable to mythical beings were descending, exuding a presence that threatened to shatter this world at any moment.

「It was time for the protagonists of this story to appear.」

<Kim Dokja Company>, they were finally about to reveal themselves on the stage.

"Ahjussi."

It was then that Shin Yoosung spoke, her voice trembling.

"Something is wrong."

The striking lightning bolt landed directly on Snowfield's head. Snowfield hurriedly bowed his head, and 'Drinking Demon' moved to protect him. The thunder incinerated the demon while delivering a fatal blow to Snowfield's entire body.

With one arm and one leg burned black, Snowfield looked down at his incarnation body with eyes full of distrust before snapping his head up.

"I."

Rage filled Snowfield's face as he gazed up at the sky.

"I never summoned you."

As the gates of the heavens opened, dazzling stars illuminating the entire sky simultaneously appeared.

「What appeared in the sky was not <Kim Dokja Company>.」

The scales of probability swayed precariously. Beings capable of leading this world to destruction merely by their appearance.

[The constellation, 'Spear Drawing the Boundaries of the Seas', announces its status in this region!]

Two massive eyes stood out in the sky. The main body of a myth-grade constellation, larger than a mere planet, was looking down upon this world. Even the 'White Flame Dragon of Lamentation' and the 'Drinking Demon', who aspired to rival the myth-grade, were overwhelmed by its presence and knelt.

Only Snowfield and his brother were able to gaze directly at that myth.

「Poseidon was not the only one to reveal himself.」

Another eye was visible in outer space a short distance away. Although it had only one eye, it was a being possessing a story even more powerful than the two-eyed Poseidon.

[The constellation, 'Father of the One Eye', descends in this region!]

The myth-grade constellation of <Asgard>—Odin. As if conscious of his own power, he was watching over us from a distance somewhat further away than Poseidon.

Then, two burning eyes appeared on the opposite side of the sky where Poseidon had descended.

[The constellation, 'Fire of the South', is descending upon this region!]

He was one of the myth-grade constellations of the <Emperor>, who had never revealed himself before.

「A member of the Three Sovereigns, Shennong.」

As Shennong, reminiscent of a giant of fire, moved his massive hand, the entire planet began to seethe as if it had entered a furnace.

[The power of the 'Round Table' is moving.]

[The 'Round Table' is watching over this world.]

The Round Table. The myth-grade constellations, who play dice with this world on a table, had finally intervened in this world.

A dozen pairs of eyes belonging to the 'myth-grade constellations' rose simultaneously across the vast expanse of the sky.

Snowfield faced them and asked.

"How did you get here? This is not a place you would have dared to come to."

The cowardly constellations, who had been forced to infiltrate this place as 'fragments', appeared leading their true forms. This meant that there was someone who had personally opened the 'Record' for those cowards.

As Snowfield glanced away, the Recorder, who had been concealing their presence behind the night sky, revealed themselves.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'Demon King of the Cinema', continues the recording.]

Snowfield glared in that direction with narrowed eyes, then spoke to the constellations of the sky again.

"Didn't we agree not to interfere with my event?"

However, the myth-grade constellations looked around with their massive eyes as if they couldn't hear a word Snowfield said, launching into all sorts of critiques.

[It is an interesting world.]

[It looks like the trash we sent is performing quite well.]

As if in response to those words, the constellation fragments sprawled on the ground trembled. The fragment of Odin knelt in despondency, and the fragments of Poseidon and Demeter clasped each other's hands with grim expressions. The fragment of Zeus glared at the sky with a hateful gaze.

「There is no 'fragment' that dares to defy the main body.」

The mythical constellations spoke, seemingly greatly satisfied with the sight of the fragments.

[Return, all of you. Tell us what you have learned.]

With screams, the fragments scattered into fables and soon began to be collected toward the mythical constellations.

[Oooooh—]

The mythical constellations, having acquired new fables, let out screams of ecstasy.

Snowfield looked at them with a cold expression and said,

"Leave now. All you can have is the trash you scattered here."

Then, Poseidon, having finished devouring the fables, spoke.

[That is troublesome.]

"Troublesome? Are you planning to break your promise?"

Poseidon spoke with a somewhat complex expression, chewing as if he had chewed on a strange tale from the recovered fragment.

[We and the weak were 'the largest fragment of the Oldest Dream'.]

At Poseidon's words, Snowfield's gaze grew cold.

[Can you still say that you are 'the largest fragment of the Oldest Dream'?]

"I am still the 'largest fragment'."

[Well. At least in this world, I don't think so.]

Poseidon's sinister eyes turned toward Snowfield and his brother. Following this, deep greed flickered in the eyes of the myth-grade constellations.

[It seems we have arrived at just the right time.]

[Has the 'dream takeover' not begun yet?]

[The 'Oldest Dream' will be completed soon.]

With each incantation from the myth-grade constellations, the rift in the world deepened.

Snowfield muttered with a bitter smile.

"It was a mistake to expect anything from you in the first place. Have you given up on seeing a proper ■■?"

Shennong burst into loud laughter.

[A proper ■■! Do you really mean to dream such a dream for us?"]

"..."

[Until now, I have avoided conflict out of fear of your power, but here, where you cannot properly wield your power, it is a different story.]

As if shattering a world like this were nothing, Shennong's burning hand began to engulf the world.

[The stars will choose their own fate. You shall obediently become the stars' 'dream'.]

Snowfield's expression hardened. The purpose of the powerful myth-grade constellations here, defying even probability, was clear.

「They were all waiting only for the moment when the 'largest fragments' of the 'Oldest Dream' would gather.」

The reason the 'myth-grade constellations' of the Round Table had held their breath, neglecting even the 'Ragnarok' scenario of mass destruction.

「To directly seize the power of the 'Oldest Dream' into their own hands.」

The city was engulfed in flames, and the snow-capped stars, unable to withstand the heat, shattered. Even Snowfield could not stop this catastrophe this time. Nevertheless, Snowfield remained calm.

"Have you forgotten, you foolish stars?"

There was a reason why the Outer Gods, despite noticing the existence of this worldline, could not interfere.

"'What kind of star' exists here."

That was the reason this worldline was called a 'prison', and the reason why no one who entered this worldline could ever escape.

「Somewhere, the sound of the scales of probability shifting was heard.」

The moment the myth-grade constellations held their breath simultaneously at that ominous sound.

[Aaaargh!]

Shennong, who had been burning the world, screamed and clutched one of his eyes. His single eye, floating in the sky, turned red and poured out stories. Upon closer inspection, a massive staff was embedded in the center of the eye.

「The Ruyi Jingu Staff.」

Across the sky, which was filled with the starlight of the constellations, a massive pair of eyes appeared.

As Hwain Geumjeong—the golden eyes that had not burned even in the Eight Trigram Furnace of Taesang Nogun—glared at the stars, the entire universe was enveloped in a moment of silence.

[I surely warned you.]

He was a being who had long since gathered all his fragments to reach the 'Great Myth'.

A star who rejected the Round Table of his own accord and abandoned even the universe of the <Star Stream>.

[I said I would shatter every single star that enters this world without exception.]

Once a prisoner in the world's smallest prison, now a being possessing terrifying power capable of scorning even other myth-grade constellations.

[The constellation, 'Oldest Liberator', reveals its true power!]

Sensing the danger, the myth-grade constellations simultaneously unleashed their true powers.

[Danger—]

The next moment, the far side of the sky flashed, and the entire universe was engulfed in bright light. A clash of myths. Amidst the flooding stories, countless stars were swept away, and a miracle unfolded in which an entire galaxy was erased.

The shape of a gigantic 'Golden Shackle' rose into the sky.

The reason this world, which was swaying precariously, was barely holding on was entirely because the Golden Shackle of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal enveloped its outer boundaries.

Watching this scene, Snowfield slowly looked at his brother and spoke.

"You know it, don't you? The Great Sage Heaven's Equal alone cannot stop them."

No matter how great the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was, his opponents were the myth-grade constellations of the 'Round Table'. While it was unclear for now, it was only natural that he alone could not protect this world and face them all.

In fact, the top-tier myth-grade constellations, including Odin, had not even joined this battle yet.

"Now that myth-grade constellations have appeared, this world is bound to be destroyed by the aftermath anyway. If the Great Sage Heaven's Equal is left as he is, he will die."

From afar, the lion's roar of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal could be heard. He was protecting this world, staking every story on it.

Amidst the bright, exploding halo of golden stories, Snowfield spoke.

"If you want to save him, dream the same dream as I do."

As Snowfield looked at his brother, his brother looked back at him. The gazes of the two Kim Dokjas clashed in the air, and a single dream flickered.

「The only way to stop those myth-grade constellations in this universe.」

The 'dream' Snowfield spoke of was clear.

"We must summon <Kim Dokja Company> here."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1005 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (5)

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「Summoning <Kim Dokja Company> here to save the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.」

It was an offer Kim Dokja could not refuse. While <Kim Dokja Company> was one thing, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was Kim Dokja's brother.

He was the star who had staked all his stories to protect Kim Dokja's ending.

"Cooperate. Otherwise, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal will die."

Snowfield urged his silent brother once again.

"They must come to save the Great Sage Heaven's Equal. Only they possess the probability of properly descending here."

The stories of <Kim Dokja Company> are present here now. The two brothers, the greatest fragments of Kim Dokja, were here, as were Shin Yoosung, Lee Hyunsung, and Jung Heewon of <Kim Dokja Company>.

Is that all? Even the conditions for a 'tilted scale' where other powerful Outer Gods would intervene were met.

So there was no reason to refuse. Protecting this measly world?

Compared to summoning <Kim Dokja Company> and saving the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, what was so important about that?

「Nevertheless, his brother slowly shook his head.」

As if unable to believe the record appearing before his eyes, Snowfield asked.

"Are you serious?"

"Yes."

The brother simply looked at the Great Sage Heaven's Equal in the void with sorrowful eyes. He could tell from his expression. His brother clearly wanted to save the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

「Nevertheless, his brother declared that he would not summon <Kim Dokja Company> here.」

Snowfield could not understand what kind of resolve that was. An inexplicable emotion surged within him.

"How... if you really are 'Kim Dokja'—"

Snowfield spoke in a somewhat agitated voice.

"If you really are Kim Dokja, you would never drive your loved ones into a death trap."

At that, his brother turned to him and spoke.

"Is bringing <Kim Dokja Company> here for the sake of 'the people I love'?"

Snowfield tried to answer yes. But strangely, no voice came out. His brother continued speaking.

"You left all of that outside, so you don't understand why you are trying to realize that 'story' right now."

Tsutsutsutsu.

Snowfield stared at the faint spark burning at his fingertips.

His story was reacting. It was giving orders. To bring <Kim Dokja Company> here immediately.

「Is this really 'my' thought?」

A faint dizziness arose. In the distance, he could see the remains of fragments absorbed by the constellations.

「What exactly is this 'me' now?」

Existing merely as a fragment of the 'main body', what difference is there between him and those star fragments?

Snowfield slowly inhaled and spoke again.

"No matter what purpose I have in summoning <Kim Dokja Company>, if they do not come, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal will die."

Snowfield put his thoughts aside. It did not matter who he was or why he was trying to realize this story.

What mattered was achieving the purpose for which the main body had deployed him here.

"Dream right now. Imagine the same thing as me."

Saying this, Snowfield gripped his brother's shoulder tightly. However, his brother lightly swatted his hand away and said,

"There is no need for that."

A formidable story began to flow from his brother's entire body.

"I will deal with them alone."

Snowfield's eyes slowly widened.

「The brother before me is a being who has reached myth by accumulating stories on his own.」

The stories his brother had built up until now revealed their power all at once.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Great King of Fear', begins its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage', begins its storytelling.]

The stories his brother had gathered were shining brightly. Watching the stories flowing from his entire body, Snowfield realized something. His brother was sincere right now. He was going to stake everything on stopping those constellations without the help of <Kim Dokja Company>.

"That won't do."

Something creaked and went awry inside Snowfield.

"Unless you dream the same dream as me."

Along with the pitch-black story flowing out, Snowfield spoke.

"I will kill you right now and take your stories."

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Immediately after absorbing Dansu ahjussi, something strange happened to me. To get straight to the point, it wasn't 'me' moving my body right now. It felt as if 'me' had been split in two. Another 'me' was moving my body and speaking like me. No, to be more precise—

[Your 'Exclusive Trait' is evolving!]

'The other me' was just like the 'Kim Dokja' I had imagined for a long time.

"Watch over me from there."

Exuding an overwhelming presence, he subdued the constellations and moved my body in my place.

「Strong, cool-headed, and composed Kim Dokja.」

It felt as if a single concept named 'Kim Dokja' was moving my body.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', smiles with satisfaction.]

Perhaps that is why. For a moment, a temptation arose. What if I were to entrust everything to this 'Kim Dokja'? What if I were to step back and record everything as he moved forward?

「If I were to live as his recorder just like this.」

The moment I thought that far, I was suddenly seized by a sensation as if the ground beneath my feet were giving way.

['■■■'s ■■' stares at you.]

Something was staring at me. The sensation of a muddy sea was dragging my soul along from my feet. A certain world, something within that world, was calling out to me strongly.

「I know where that place is.」

A faint question from a baby.

I felt as if my soul were melting away. If things continue like this for just a little longer, I will be completely sucked into the world where 'that thing' exists.

At that moment, something awakened me.

「Not yet」

The sentence from the [Fourth Wall] that I had heard before. From whom on earth was this sentence transmitted?

「No t yet the ti me」

Does saying it is not the time mean that someday the time will come to go there?

「Con ti nue the story」

With a sudden jolting sensation, my floating soul aligned with my incarnation body.

"Stop right now!"

I saw Snowfield shouting at me and swinging his fist. Amidst my accelerated perception, I took a deep breath and glared at that fist.

['■■■'s ■■' withdraws its gaze from you.]

[The evolution of the exclusive trait stops.]

I felt the story flowing through my veins. The grip of my entire body was returning. The concept of 'Kim Dokja' that had driven me scattered, and my body became mine again.

"Don't interfere."

I spoke in a cold voice as I parried Snowfield's punch.

"If you cherish that star even a little, don't interfere with me."

But Snowfield was not in a position to listen to me. I let out a short breath and struck Snowfield's jaw hard as he lunged at me. Snowfield staggered violently, yet he clung to my waist.

"The story I wanted is right in front of me."

Stories were flowing profusely from Snowfield's nose like blood as he held me. I got goosebumps the moment I met his eyes.

「The total amount of 'Kim Dokja Fragments' Snowfield possesses here is less than mine.」

However, just because the total amount of stories he possessed was small did not mean he could not interfere with me.

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', stops its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Great King of Fear', stops its storytelling.]

[The story, 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage', stops its storytelling.]

Snowfield also holds a certain share in the stories I possess. Right now, Snowfield was staking all of his stories to blockade my story.

I tried to shake Snowfield off somehow, but he clung to me even more tightly like a leech. I urgently looked up at the sky.

Rumble!

A rough thunderclap echoed. Stories were exploding like fireworks from all directions of the universe. The roar of enraged myth-grade constellations. Standing proudly at the center of the heavens, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was fighting valiantly, absorbing the attacks of the stars.

[You damned monkey!]

[Blow the whole world away!]

From afar, I could see the furious power of the story swirling. A bombardment of pure story imbued with the authority of myth-grade constellations. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal continued the fight, wielding the Ruyi Golden Staff and sometimes deflecting bombardment with his Cloud Somersault.

However, his starlight was gradually fading. No matter how much he had awakened the power of the 'Oldest Liberator', he could not stand against all of them while protecting this world. It was just as Snowfield had said. At this rate, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal would die.

「He had to make a choice.」

Whether to summon <Kim Dokja Company> here, or to let the Great Sage Heaven's Equal die.

"Ahjussi, stop. Please—"

Shin Yoosung approached us with a pale face. Had she grasped the situation? She was looking at Snowfield.

"Please stop."

Despite Shin Yoosung's plea, Snowfield did not let go of my waist. His body was slowly crumbling under the sparks of probability. Shin Yoosung, who had been gazing at the snowy landscape, hurriedly looked up at the sky and squeezed her eyes shut as if she had made a decision.

"Chimera Dragon!"

The Chimera Dragon, which had been fighting against the Great Sage Heaven's Equal until the end of the war, roared and covered the rooftop in shadow. Shin Yoosung lightly stroked the Chimera Dragon's face, then turned to me with determined eyes and said.

"I will stop it. I won't let the Great Sage Heaven's Equal die."

Riding the Chimera Dragon, Shin Yoosung flew straight toward the stars.

"Yoosoung-ah, no!"

I reached out my hand toward Shin Yoosung as she sped away. Thunder rumbled from the sky once again. I grabbed Snowfield by the collar and said.

"Let go. Are you going to let Yoosoung die too?"

"…"

"The Yoosoung of today cannot fight against the stars."

Beast Lord Shin Yoosung is strong. However, if her story is in an unstable state like this, it is a different story. She was not in a position to face a myth-grade constellation like the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

Snowfield simply laughed as she poured out her stories.

"Imagine, Kim Dokja."

That persistence sent a chill down my spine. I couldn't understand Snowfield's mind. Did he really believe that by summoning <Kim Dokja Company> like this, he could see the ending he desired?

"Dokja-ssi!"

Just then, Jung Heewon carried Lee Hyunsung up to the rooftop. Some of the myth-grade constellations floating in the sky stared in this direction.

[Kim Dok ja Com pa ny.]

That 'Jung Heewon' right now was the Jung Heewon of the 41st round. And Lee Hyunsung was unconscious. If even a single myth-grade constellation were to descend upon this rooftop in this situation—

「There was no other way now.」

I released my stories and began to imagine. Noticing my change, Snowfield beamed and said.

"Yes, that is it."

Shin Yoosung, Jung Heewon, and even Lee Hyunsung. The three of <Kim Dokja Company> had gathered here. The story of <Kim Dokja Company> had reached the extreme limit of strength.

「Two Kim Dokjas have gathered, and finally, they began to dream.」

The thunder in the sky grew louder. Receiving the imagination of the 'Oldest Dream', the gates of the world were opening.

[Something is approaching!]

A myth-grade constellation shouted as if to warn. However, a bolt of lightning flew in faster than that warning. It was neither Odin's nor Zeus's. That lightning was a power built solely by the strength of a pure human.

The Thunder of the Heaven-Shattering.

At the lightning strike that flew in tearing through the sky, the mythical constellations groaned and retreated. In the darkness where the stars had withdrawn, a man stood.

「With his pitch-black coat fluttering in the wind, the regressor with piercing eyes stared at the world.」

It was only the moment he read that record that Snowfield let go of my waist. He staggered to his feet. As if welcoming a very old friend, he stood there and called out the name of the man coming down toward him.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

Snowfield approached him with a face radiant with joy.

"You have finally come."

However, Yoo Joonghyuk glanced at him briefly, then turned his head this way and that.

「And Snowfield could never forget the words that followed from Yoo Joonghyuk.」

"Where is Kim Dokja?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1006 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (6)

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Snowfield stood motionless, as if struck hard on the back of the head with a blunt object, and turned to look at Yoo Joonghyuk and at me. Just then, Yoo Joonghyuk's gaze also fixed on me. Upon confirming my presence, Yoo Joonghyuk frowned slightly, then immediately gazed at the sky I had been looking at.

"You always seek me out only at moments like this."

The constellations in the night sky, having confirmed Yoo Joonghyuk's existence, let out a furious roar.

[Puppet of the Oldest Dream—!]

The stars in the sky blinked violently. Countless starlight poured down upon Yoo Joonghyuk's head. A few steps away from that maddening stage—an unreal landscape where the entire universe flickered—Snowfield was simply looking at me with bewildered eyes. It was a face that showed absolutely no understanding of what on earth was happening.

Looking at him, I said.

"I cannot dream the same dream as you."

Only after hearing those words did Snowfield's eyes slowly return to their normal state. As if realizing something belatedly, he flinched, his shoulders trembling, and turned to look at Yoo Joonghyuk.

"No way."

A black coat fluttering in the breeze. The man standing there was undoubtedly Yoo Joonghyuk. However, just as we are not the Kim Dokja of <Kim Dokja Company>, neither was Yoo Joonghyuk.

The moment he checked the spear clutched in his hand, Snowfield staggered and spoke.

"How on earth—that Yoo Joonghyuk."

He was the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round who had walked through the history of this world with me.

"Because the stories of <Kim Dokja Company> aren't the only ones here."

[Your 'Giant Story' continues its storytelling.]

Feeling the stories overflowing within me, I spoke.

"Just as the Kim Dokja known by <Kim Dokja Company> isn't the only Kim Dokja, the Yoo Joonghyuk you knew isn't the only Yoo Joonghyuk either."

「The power of the 'Oldest Dream' is to realize one's own 'dream'.」

There was clearly a story of <Kim Dokja Company> here. However, within me now, there existed a narrative that had formed layers perhaps just as powerful.

「I imagined the Yoo Joonghyuk I needed.」

What Snowfield is looking at right now is the story he has always loved.

「This is the story of the side story."」

Like someone whose heart has collapsed, Snowfield slowly knelt. I watched him for a moment, then turned my head away. There was no time to feel pity for him right now.

[Your 'Giant Story' is advancing toward the grain.]

[Your 'Giant Story' is nearing the 'Super Giant Story'.]

I moved my steps and stood beside Yoo Joonghyuk. Yoo Joonghyuk glanced at me and adjusted his grip on his spear. I asked.

"Can you kill at least one myth-grade constellation now?"

Instead of answering, Yoo Joonghyuk held up his spear. A heavy, finely crafted black spear.

「Dark Heaven Moon Spear.」

To complete that spear, Yoo Joonghyuk must have slain countless stars and demon lords in places I do not know. He must have gathered stories of light and darkness, and asked the greatest blacksmith to forge this spear using the metal of those stories.

[The Holy Relic, 'Dark Heaven Moon Spear', roars!]

As the spear, imbued with the vengeful spirits of countless stars and demon lords, howled, Yoo Joonghyuk's stories imbued themselves upon its surface. A mysterious energy bloomed from the spear, which possessed beautiful ridges that looked as if the moon had been pressed into the darkness. I recognized that martial art immediately.

「Divine Spear of Annihilation.」

It was a martial art perfected to shatter the ancient myths of the heavens.

「He is now fully capable of bearing the myths of the heavens.」

Yoo Joonghyuk was proving this with his own stories. Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been observing me, asked.

"What about you?"

"Check it out for yourself."

We looked up at the sky together.

「This is a story to change the ending of the 41st round.」

Jung Heewon, carrying Lee Hyunsung on her back, also approached us and stood beside us.

"Can I abandon this person now?"

The grumbling Jung Heewon and Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes met briefly. It seemed as though sparks flew between their gazes for a moment.

"You've become stronger."

As Yoo Joonghyuk spoke, Jung Heewon twitched her lips in frustration and replied.

"You too."

It seemed that Jung Heewon realized the gap still hanging between her and Yoo Joonghyuk just from that brief exchange of gazes.

「Thus, the two disciples of Breaking the Sky gathered in one place.」

Just then, we saw the nerve of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who had been battling the stars in the void, descending toward us.

[Aaaargh! You damned monkey!]

Even in the midst of this, a fierce battle was raging in the open sky. The sight of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, split into countless fragments, fighting against the stars. It appeared that his signature technique, the [Clone Technique], had been unleashed.

Even while fighting against myth-grade constellations, he still possessed the capacity to send his true form toward us. I could not even fathom the extent of his capabilities at this moment.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal observed Yoo Joonghyuk and Jung Heewon, then turned to me and spoke.

[The youngest is…]

I bowed my head. The 'youngest' he was looking for was not me.

"I am sorry."

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal remained silent for a moment.

「I told him that I would protect 'the third Kim Dokja'.」

However, the third Kim Dokja eventually entered the [Fourth Wall] that I possess. By now, he has likely met the 'Demon King of Salvation' and the 'Great King of Fear'. Perhaps he is watching this very scene through the wall.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who had been silently staring at me, strode toward me. I could not tell from his expression whether he was angry or not. Yoo Joonghyuk and Jung Heewon stood blocking my path, their expressions hardening. I shook my head to signal to them that I was fine. As they stepped aside, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal stood before me, looking down at me.

I opened my mouth to him as if making an excuse.

"Kim Dokja is inside me. Probably inside the [Fourth Wall]—"

It was a pathetic excuse to claim that he hadn't been completely absorbed by me.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal shook his head silently and then spoke.

[I know.]

"Yes?"

[To be precise, I should say I knew.]

He looked up somewhere in the void. As if reading a record invisible to me, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal added like a sigh.

[The Recorder told me. That it would eventually turn out this way. That everything is already written, and is being written simultaneously.]

Which recorder could have told the Great Sage Heaven's Equal this story?

Strangely, I had a feeling that it might be Han Sooyoung.

"We will help."

I spoke while gazing at the battlefield in the sky. Here, I am, Yoo Joonghyuk is, and Jung Heewon is. Now that Snowfield cannot dream a proper dream, if we join forces, we might be able to fend off the relentless assault of those myth-grade constellations.

[No, it is not necessary.]

"Huh?"

[Leave this world.]

A deep pain rose from somewhere in my heart. Perhaps it was the third's feelings toward the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

"But this house—"

[It’s hard to even call it a house anymore.]

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal scanned the city center with somewhat hollow eyes. There stood a world reduced to ruins by flooded snowstorms. The corpses of the dead. The collapsed major facilities of the city. In the distance, the house where the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and his brothers used to live together was visible. The house had been half-destroyed by a meteorite that had flown in from somewhere.

[Perhaps it was our fate from the very beginning. It was probably impossible with just the efforts of me and the other two.]

At the Great Sage Heaven's Equal’s muttered words, I shook my head and tried to say something. But the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was faster.

[As expected, that guy suits being by everyone’s side better.]

I was speechless for a moment. It seemed that the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had been thinking that all along while living here with Kim Dokja.

「If so, with what heart has the Great Sage Heaven's Equal protected Kim Dokja here?」

Why did the Great Sage Heaven's Equal protect this fleeting daily life, this simple story, so desperately?

[If the youngest entrusted the future to you, there must be a reason.]

Why has this star, which was once weary of all stories, illuminated this world with such a bright light?

[Please show the youngest a proper 'home'.]

Some blank spaces cannot be fully filled, even by the power of a recorder. At that moment, I wanted to shed light on the Great Sage Heaven's Equal’s unspoken heart. I wanted to draw out at least a single word from that vastness. However, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal interrupted me with a serious expression.

[And soon, 'it' will strike.]

'It'?

"The time has come."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded, as if he immediately understood what the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was saying. Jung Heewon looked at me as if to say, "What is that sound?" Something belatedly occurred to me as well.

「Right now, in this universe, a massive event was unfolding that would shake the probability of the <Star Stream>.」

The clash of myth-grade constellations unfolding before my eyes was a type of event rarely seen even in the main story.

If the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's 'Golden Headband' had not withstood the aftershocks sweeping into this world, it would have been swept away by the constellations' furious assault and turned into cosmic dust long ago.

The surrounding universe was already in a state of complete devastation due to the overflowing power of the myth-grade constellations. With a backlash severe enough to cause serious problems on the scales of probability, the <Star Stream> will summon a being to resolve it.

[The 'Cleaner' is coming soon.]

For some time now, there has been a sinister aura emanating from across the sky. Something approaching from a great distance at high speed.

[Once it arrives here, even if I and you join forces, we cannot stop it.]

An absolute catastrophe was approaching, one that even the Great Sage Heaven's Equal could not stop. This <Star Stream> gives this catastrophe its name.

"Indescribable Distance."

Indescribable Distance—'The Nameless Mist'.

The mist at the apex of all outer spheres was approaching this world to devour the distorted probability.

[Until now, I had been hiding its coordinates with the 'Golden Sash', but that will be difficult any longer.]

With a light sigh, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal rose once again into the void.

[I will draw the attention of the stars. You guys escape in the meantime.]

"Wait a minute. And you—"

[Who are you worrying about right now?]

Laughing triumphantly, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal unleashed a barrage of lightning toward the sky once again. In response to the Great Sage's counterattack, the constellations unleashed even more powerful fire, adjusting their formations.

Yoo Joonghyuk surveyed the battlefield for a moment, then took his stance.

"There is no time, so I will break through in one go."

Yoo Joonghyuk's [Sage's Eye] began to shine brightly. Even in the midst of this, countless calculations were likely going back and forth in his head. The power and angle of the [Divine Soul Annihilation Spear], and even the star most suitable for the spear to pierce.

"Rescue Shin Yoosung and escape this place immediately. You guys cover me."

I nodded.

"What is the target?"

"Poseidon."

Poseidon, who had been withstanding the attacks of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal in the sky, roared while shedding stories. Although wounded, his body was spewing out such immense stories that even approaching him was terrifying. The mere act of approaching it as a narrative-grade constellation would cause its incarnation body to melt away.

"Do you really think you can break through?"

No matter how inferior Poseidon was compared to Zeus or Odin, he was by no means a star that could be finished off with a single spear strike.

"It is possible."

Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk said it was possible. If the current Yoo Joonghyuk says so, it must be true.

"Prepare."

"Please wait a moment."

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at me for a moment, as if asking what I was thinking. However, even if I had to listen to Yoo Joonghyuk's harsh words, there was still something I absolutely had to do before escaping this place.

I turned my head and looked at the edge of the rooftop.

「There stood Snowfield.」

Still lost in thought, his eyes held a look of utter despair, as if he had lost every story of his own.

「His <Kim Dokja Company> never came here.」

I am not sure if the reason his dream failed to come true was simply a lack of 'Kim Dokja fragments', or if it was because of me. But whatever the reason, I could not simply leave him abandoned here.

I approached him and called his name.

"Kim Dokja."

At that, Snowfield looked at me. As if cursing me for calling him by that name, deep hatred was rising in his eyes. Reaching out my hand toward that hatred, I said.

"Let's go together."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1007 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (7)

Upon hearing my words, Snowfield’s eyes went blank for a moment. He asked back, as if doubting what he had heard.

"What did you say?"

"Didn't you hear? I said let's go together."

A shadow of anger flickered in Snowfield’s eyes.

"What do you mean by that?"

He looked ready to pounce on me at any moment, depending on my answer. I stared at him calmly and said.

"I was just being realistic. There is nothing more you can do even if you stay here."

What stood before me was a fragment of 'Snowfield'. He must have come here on some kind of order from his main body. It wasn't difficult to guess what that order might be.

「To summon <Kim Dokja Company> and recreate the 'Big House'.」

I don't know why Snowfield chose to recreate that story specifically here, or why he didn't come in person if he intended to recreate it. But regardless, his plan has failed.

"You know it, too. <Kim Dokja Company> isn't coming."

I can clearly feel <Kim Dokja Company> existing far beyond the universe. However, I didn't get the feeling they were approaching. It seemed that at the last moment, <Kim Dokja Company> had turned in a different direction. Perhaps they headed somewhere where a more urgent matter had arisen.

"Staying here will only lead to a meaningless death. So let's go back."

Snowfield frowned at the hand I held out and asked in a low voice.

"Where to?"

"Anywhere."

"Have you forgotten that you were punching me just moments ago?"

"I remember. And I know the fight isn't over yet."

We simply couldn't settle the score with Snowfield this time; eventually, he and I will have to settle it.

Snowfield asked, looking puzzled.

"Why are you making this proposal? You surely have other ways."

"Other ways?"

"Absorbing me right now."

Snowfield threw open his collar as he spoke those words. On his chest, stories were rippling like a tattoo.

「There stood the 'Kim Dokjas' collected by Snowfield.」

Stories pulsating closest to the heart. Stories of those born as Kim Dokja, whether they wanted it or not, who had to become Kim Dokja, and thus became Kim Dokja.

"If you take me here, you can become a true Kim Dokja."

I felt a burning emotion in Snowfield's eyes. A very old and deep hunger. Perhaps Snowfield had come this far intoxicated by that emotion, absorbing other 'Kim Dokjas' time and time again.

「Kim Dok ja」

The stories were shouting from within him. The voices of fragments yearning for a single 'Kim Dokja' pierced my ears like an echo. My heart pounded, and the blood flow through my body quickened.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', licks his lips.]

I opened my mouth, strongly suppressing my boiling emotions.

"If we gather all the fragments."

From a distance, I could see stories coalescing into Yoo Joonghyuk's spear. Without taking my eyes off the scene, I asked.

"Do you really think he can become the 'Kim Dokja' we envision?"

Snowfield did not answer immediately. It was not a question I had asked expecting an answer in the first place. Neither he nor I would ever know the answer.

Biting his lip tightly, Snowfield spoke again.

"I don't know. Still, all I can do is—"

"Gathering fragments? Even if that is the case, let's not do it here."

As Snowfield said, subduing and absorbing him here might be helpful for the upcoming battles.

「But is that really the only way?」

I thought of the third Kim Dokja, who had not wanted his brothers to fight. Is it truly fitting for this story's ending to have every Kim Dokja engage in a bloody battle until the very end, with only a single Kim Dokja surviving?

"I have no intention of settling this matter with you here. If we were to engage in a clumsy brawl among ourselves here, only the innocent guys would benefit."

I thought of Asmodeus, who was watching over us from across the sky. He had suddenly barged into the battlefield i the 'Fear Realm' and stolen a fragment of the 'King of Fear' as well. He was probably hiding, waiting for an opportunity, just like he did back then.

Snowfield looked at me with a complex gaze. I took that as his own form of consent.

"You made the right decision."

As I took the first step, he followed me a beat late.

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been engrossed in the story, glanced over at us and asked.

"Is the story over?"

"Yes. You may depart now."

For a brief moment, Yoo Joonghyuk's gaze rested on Snowfield.

"Looking at him again, he resembles you a little."

I replied with a bitter smile.

"Resemble? We look exactly alike. What nonsense."

In fact, aside from our hair color, Snowfield and I looked practically like twins.

Yoo Joonghyuk shook his head and said.

"You don't look exactly alike. Are your eyes small, so your eyesight is bad too?"

"They aren't small; I just squinted."

Snowfield watched from the side as I exchanged nonsense with Yoo Joonghyuk. Honestly, watching that didn't make me feel very comfortable. What was that guy thinking right now, having waited so long for <Kim Dokja Company> but never meeting it?

"Preparations are complete."

Yoo Joonghyuk's spear, having finished his preparations, aimed at the empty sky. Even the myth-grade constellations of the Azure Sky witnessed us.

[Block it.]

It was Poseidon who unleashed his technique first. A massive spear was summoned into the grasp of Poseidon, capable of engulfing an entire planet. I knew it instinctively. Just by swinging that spear, not only would everyone here be annihilated, but this world—this entire planet—would be shattered.

With a roar that tore through the entire atmosphere, Poseidon's spear flew toward us. Honestly, it felt less like a spear and more like a meteor.

Even though the spear had pierced the atmosphere, Yoo Joonghyuk did not use [Divine Spear of Annihilation]. As if waiting for something. And just when he felt he couldn't wait any longer...

Kagagagagang!

With a faint shattering sound, the trajectory of the spear unleashed by Poseidon twisted. The swollen Ruyi Golden Staff of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was twisting the trajectory of the Trident. Leaving behind a tremendous backblast, the Trident passed right past this world.

[Go!]

At the signal of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, Yoo Joonghyuk's spear moved. I had once seen Yoo Joonghyuk's [Soul-Slaying Divine Spear]. However, the trajectory of the spear tracing before my eyes now was completely different from the [Soul-Slaying Divine Spear] I remembered.

Soul-Slaying Divine Spear.

First Form.

Annihilation Form.

The tip of the [Soul-Slaying Divine Spear] fired, leaving a dazzling tail behind. A spear thrust advancing with a speed that was not fast, but certainly steady.

Poseidon spoke with a mocking laugh.

[With the technique of a mere mortal—]

But Poseidon's laughter vanished in an instant. The Annihilation Form, which had clearly appeared as a single flash of light at first, changed its form the moment it pierced the atmosphere and soared. A spear thrust spinning as if sucking in every story in the area. What was initially a small mass of story had transformed into a massive mass of story by the time it broke through the stratosphere.

[What.]

Poseidon hurriedly unleashed his power, but the [Soul-Destruction Divine Spear], having gained momentum, became a single flash of light and pierced straight through Poseidon's palm.

[Aaaargh! How dare you!]

It was a devastating blow. A strike that pierced the true form of a 'myth-grade constellation', neither a demigod descending nor an incarnation body. Finally, the 41st Yoo Joonghyuk had become a transcendent of such supreme realm.

"Let's go. The opening will be brief."

Yoo Joonghyuk retrieved the spear and took the lead, followed by Jung Heewon and me. Snowfield was also steadily following behind us.

"There is a rift in the 'Void Veil' that the myth-grade constellations tore through. We will exit through there."

As Poseidon's energy clearly weakened, the 'Void Veil' rippling beyond it became much clearer.

The boundary of the world. If only we could enter that rift, we could escape this world.

"Something is coming."

It was then that the voice from Snowfield was heard. I wonder when it had started. A sinister, low-lying lightning strike was chasing us. From a distance, Odin's single eye was watching us.

"Odin."

Yoo Joonghyuk gripped his Dark Heavenly Moon Spear tighter, as if chewing on it. With a hardened expression, Yoo Joonghyuk unleashed his energy, but the range of the lightning wave was too vast for him to block alone. Just as Jung Heewon and I were about to step forward, a massive shadow enveloped us, taking Odin's lightning strike instead.

Kaaaaaaaak—!

The 'Chimera Dragon' let out a terrible scream after taking the lightning. I saw the shattered body of the 'Chimera Dragon' being transported somewhere. Amidst the scattering of the dragon's body, the unconscious Shin Yoosung was falling.

"Yoosoung-ah!"

In the meantime, Poseidon, having regained his strength, swung his massive palm toward us. The sheer pressure was such that it felt as though my incarnation body would be

crushed just by the touch.

Yoo Joonghyuk spoke.

"Save Shin Yoosung. Jung Heewon will stop him with me."

Jung Heewon nodded and stood beside Yoo Joonghyuk, while I approached Shin Yoosung, utilizing [Way of the Wind] with full force.

Just then, several constellations spotted me. An arrow flying from somewhere grazed my shoulder. Even though it was merely a graze, pain surged through me as if my entire shoulder were about to be torn off. Enduring the pain, I reached out my left hand toward the falling Shin Yoosung.

"Yoosoung-ah! Catch it!"

However, the unconscious Shin Yoosung did not respond. I gritted my teeth and increased my acceleration.

"Shin Yoosung!"

But just before my hand touched the child's collar, an intense spark consumed my body.

「'Kim Dokja' will not be able to save 'Shin Yoosung'.」

A chill ran down my spine. It was [Fate]. In that brief moment, the recorders who had sided with the other party had bestowed this damn [Fate] upon me.

I could not tell if it was the work of Asmodeus or another recorder.

"Damn it—"

While I was caught in the spark, Shin Yoosung's hand began to slowly move away. Just as I belatedly emitted stories to accelerate toward Shin Yoosung again, something overtook me and grabbed her.

Pitch-black feathers scattered in the air.

I stared blankly at the back of the man who had saved Shin Yoosung.

「There were two 'Kim Dokjas' here.」

Snowfield embraced Shin Yoosung.

"You—"

I checked on Snowfield's condition. Judging by the fact that the aftershocks of probability were not affecting him, fortunately, it seemed [Fate] had only worked on me. Shin Yoosung, nestled in Snowfield's arms, curled up and muttered.

"Ahjussi..."

Snowfield was looking down at her with a deeply subdued gaze.

I let out a sigh of relief and said,

"Well done. Let's go back quickly."

But Snowfield did not move.

"There is something I want to ask you."

"Later. There's no time."

"What do you think 'Kim Dokja' is?"

A loud explosion erupted in the distance. I saw Yoo Joonghyuk and Jung Heewon receiving Poseidon's palm.

"How can you be so sure that you are Kim Dokja?"

The moment I saw Snowfield's expression, I was certain. If I didn't answer that question, Snowfield wouldn't move.

Checking on Shin Yoosung, who was in his arms, I said,

"No one can be certain of what they are."

This wasn't just Kim Dokja's story. It was the same even before he acquired the name Kim Dokja. I still don't really know who I am.

"There are people who believe I am 'Kim Dokja'."

I thought of the comrades who had called me Kim Dokja. I thought of my brothers inside the [Fourth Wall] who believed me to be 'Kim Dokja'.

A name is something that is given meaning only by the person who reads and calls it.

Even if I were to obtain the 100% fragment, if no one remained in this world to call that name, then can I still say that I am 'Kim Dokja'?

"I want to protect those people. I want to show them all a just ending. That's all."

Snowfield remained silent for a moment, lost in thought at my answer. Then, Yoo Joonghyuk's shout was heard from afar.

"Kim Dokja!"

We simultaneously activated [Way of the Wind].

[You bastards—]

An enraged Poseidon poured stories from his palms and clapped his hands. Along with a roar that sounded as if the universe were distorting, the sound of waves could be heard from somewhere.

A distant tsunami of stories was rushing in. Just a single clap. A miracle that creates a 'sea zone' with just that. I realized Poseidon's true power anew. Although he suffers terrible humiliation at the hands of Yoo Joonghyuk every time, that was nonetheless the true power of Poseidon, a member of the 'Round Table'.

This time, even the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was struggling to help us. Yoo Joonghyuk was the only one we could rely on.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

And Yoo Joonghyuk's Dark Heavenly Moon Spear moved.

Divine Spear of Annihilation.

Ultimate Technique.

Beside him, that Jung Heewon’s eyes widened at the sight. It seemed Jung Heewon had sensed the nature of the martial arts Yoo Joonghyuk was about to unleash.

I, too, felt I knew the original form of that martial art. Perhaps that ultimate technique—

「"My disciple."」

A martial art created by Yoo Joonghyuk while longing for his master.

「"Yes, that is how it is done."」

In an instant, the shadow of the Heaven-Shattering Sword Saint overlapped with Yoo Joonghyuk.

An extremely refined, truly beautiful sword stroke of the Heaven-Shattering Sword.

Yoo Joonghyuk’s spear moved, following the trajectory of that sword stroke.

The Soul-Shattering Meteor Strike.

The spiritual energy emanating from Yoo Joonghyuk’s spear stroke transformed into a meteor shower. The cluster of meteors soon scattered a mysterious aurora as it shot toward the universe.

「A martial art created to bring down all the stars from the sky.」

A martial art reminiscent of the Heaven-Shattering Sword Saint’s Heaven-Shattering Meteor Technique.

However, its power surpassed even the Heaven-Shattering Meteor Technique.

[How.]

Along with Poseidon's cry of astonishment, a baptism of meteors shattered the waves of the gods.

Poseidon struck by the meteor shower everywhere screamed. Poseidon's tattered true form was slowly crumbling.

Yoo Joonghyuk, sweating incessantly, spoke as if encouraging us.

"Break through."

As Poseidon collapsed, a great commotion spread among the stars in the area. We did not miss the opportunity and ran. The 'rift' was now right in front of us.

"Kim Dokja."

In an instant, I turned to look beside me. But the voice I heard was neither Yoo Joonghyuk's nor Jung Heewon's. When I turned around, Snowfield was looking at me.

「Snowfield called me 'Kim Dokja'.」

As our eyes met, Snowfield spoke again.

"There is something I want to tell you."

Perhaps because the rift was right in front of us, I could see Snowfield's body scattering little by little. Perhaps his true form was calling him, and it seemed to be there.

「The moment he connected with his main body, some of Snowfield's forgotten memories returned.」

I realized it instinctively. Snowfield was trying to convey some information to me.

"My main body—"

Strong sparks flickered across Snowfield's entire body as he opened his mouth. It seemed that Snowfield's 'main body' did not want to convey what he was about to say.

Nevertheless, he looked at me and continued speaking.

"He knew that <Kim Dokja Company> would not come here."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1008 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (8)

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I repeated Snowfield's words to myself.

「"My main body knew that Kim Dokja Company would not come here."」

To put it simply, that meant the following:

「Snowfield knew that his fragment would fail here.」

I couldn't understand it. Why did Snowfield execute it even though he foresaw his own failure?

「The fact that he went out of his way to execute a plan destined for failure means that Snowfield needed this 'failure'.」

Not 'success', but 'failure' was needed... What on earth did that mean? The moment I thought that far, a chilling thought ran down my spine.

「Everything in this world eventually becomes a 'story'.」

His 'failure' would become a story. If so, did Snowfield need a 'failing story'?

Reaching out my hand as if to catch the scattering fragment of Snowfield, I asked.

"What does that mean—"

But before I could even finish my sentence, a corner of the sky collapsed, and something shot out toward me.

【Hahahahaha! I have been waiting for this moment!】

Asmodeus's white hand tore through space and flew toward Snowfield. The damned Demon King, who had stolen Kim Dokja's fragments time and time again, had seized the opportunity once more to intervene.

I activated [Jeoninhwa] and [Way of the Wind] simultaneously to stop him. However, Asmodeus's hand was slightly faster.

The moment Asmodeus's pale hand finally wrapped around Snowfield's shoulder with a wicked laugh...

【Ah.】

With the sensation that spacetime had stopped, Asmodeus's expression hardened.

【Damn it. Since when have you known?】

For the first time, tension flickered in the eyes of Asmodeus, who had always been so nonchalant.

Snowfield slowly turned his head to look at the Demon King.

"It would be strange not to know. Considering you've been leaking such unpleasant records."

Snowfield added in a contemptuous voice while gripping Asmodeus's wrist.

"Sometimes I wonder how a guy like you became a 'Recorder of Fear'."

At Snowfield's words, a strange smile spread across Asmodeus's face.

【So, you're finally curious about my story, too?】

"No, I'm not particularly curious."

【Huh?】

"Just stay quietly tucked away in a corner of the theater until I go to find my fragments."

Following this, Snowfield's right hand moved. It was a gesture as light as the flapping of a small insect's wings.

「The small flapping of a butterfly's wings.」

However, the result of that gesture was truly astonishing.

「It shall become a storm on the other side of the universe.」

The entire space in the vicinity swept up in a vortex. Before the startled Asmodeus could even scream, his body was torn apart along with the records and sucked into the vortex.

【Kim Dok ja】

Even as he vanished, Asmodeus did not forget to leave one last remark.

【The con clu sion you de si re will ne ver come】

Snowfield gazed indifferently at the spot where Asmodeus had disappeared, then turned back to look at me.

The power to instantly eliminate Asmodeus, who is considered one of the 'Great Recorders'. I realized it clearly. The being standing before my eyes right now was not merely a 'fragment'.

"Snowfield."

Instead of answering, Snowfield smiled quietly, then immediately handed me the Shin Yoosung he was holding. Then, with distant eyes, he gazed behind me. His gaze was so poignant that I couldn't help but turn around.

"It is time to say goodbye."

Goodbye? Before I could even ask back, Snowfield spoke again.

"Let's meet again soon, brother."

When I turned around, the fragment of Snowfield had already vanished. All of his stories had drifted away, leaving behind a shimmering trail of light. Perhaps they had flowed to where his true form was.

Time, which had been creaking and tangled, began to flow again. Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been running ahead, turned around and asked.

"How is Shin Yoosung?"

"She is fine."

"Hand her over to me. It would be safer for me to handle her than for you."

"Yes."

Yoo Joonghyuk wasn't exactly wrong, so I instinctively handed Shin Yoosung over to him. However, the moment Yoo Joonghyuk looked ahead again with Shin Yoosung slung over his shoulder, I was engulfed in a strange sense of unease.

"Wait a minute. Is that all you have to say?"

"What are you talking about?"

"One person is missing from the party."

"Party?"

A look of bewilderment crossed Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes.

"What kind of nonsense are you spouting?"

I got goosebumps. Yoo Joonghyuk seemed to have absolutely no memory of 'Snowfield', who had been with us until the end of the war.

「As if Snowfield had carved his existence out of this world.」

Yoo Joonghyuk tilted his head in disbelief and glared at me, then added,

"Stop talking nonsense and get your act together. It's right in front of us now."

It was certainly just as Yoo Joonghyuk had said. Regardless of what magic Snowfield had cast, the most important thing was to safely escape this timeline.

Before we knew it, the boundary of the world was right before our eyes. The boundary of the world spewing out a dazzling golden light—a faint rift was revealed between the protective barriers created by the 'Golden Claw'. We could hear the constellations

howling in the distance, but they were not close enough to catch us. However, Jung Heewon, who was running beside us, muttered with a strange expression.

"Something is coming."

But even when we looked back, nothing was chasing us.

"It's ahead."

Yoo Joonghyuk said in a distorted voice. Pitch-black fog was rolling in from beyond the boundary. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal's warning had come true.

「An Indescribable Distance.」

The worst catastrophe of the <Star Stream>. 'The Nameless Mist' had already reached the very doorstep of this world.

"Escape with all your might."

We threw ourselves straight over the rift in the Golden Claw. As I emerged from the rift, I saw a portal swirling in the distance.

A portal leading to the 'Missing Bush'.

I knew it instinctively.

「If we go in there, we can return to the original scenario.」

However, instead of chasing after Yoo Joonghyuk, I stopped in my tracks.

"Go ahead."

"What?"

"I still have work to do."

This time, even Jung Heewon, who had been running alongside me, glared at me with wide eyes. I continued speaking.

"There is a party member that didn't come with us."

"What on earth are you talking about—"

"This time, it's not nonsense."

I turned around. Inside the rift we had just emerged from, the starlight of a constellation I knew well was twinkling.

"The Great Sage Heaven's Equal has not arrived yet."

Yoo Joonghyuk frowned.

"We must go immediately. If we delay any longer, we will be devoured by the Outer God."

I suppose so. Knowing that well, I could not leave any further.

"That star is absolutely necessary for our conclusion."

I thought that if I said this, Yoo Joonghyuk would back down. But Yoo Joonghyuk was not easily swayed.

"That star..."

Yoo Joonghyuk spoke to me in an infinitely calm voice, as if narrating a dry sentence.

"It has no intention of going with us."

"I know that, too. It is precisely because I know that I cannot go."

I had long known that the Great Sage Heaven's Equal intended to remain in this world.

He would surely try to buy time for us to leave by confronting the 'myth-grade constellations' and fending off 'The Nameless Mist'. Even if it meant losing all his stories in return.

Taking a deep breath, I conveyed my honest feelings to Yoo Joonghyuk.

"I do not want to lose any more comrades."

Yoo Joonghyuk would likely understand this feeling without needing any further explanation.

[The story, 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage', responds to your emotions.]

It was not simply because the third Kim Dokja was inside me, or because I felt his emotions along with him.

"Yoo Joonghyuk, take your comrades and go ahead. Wait for me in the final scenario."

"…"

"Don't worry. Who am I? The 'Evil Sophist' and the one called 'The One Who Deceived The Stars'—"

"You are neither the 'Evil Sophist' nor the 'One Who Deceived The Stars'."

The moment I saw Yoo Joonghyuk's piercing eyes, I was engulfed by a strange feeling. I couldn't express it in any other words.

「At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at 'me'.」

Along with the records flashing before my eyes, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke.

"Do as you please."

"Thank you."

However, there was one thing I had overlooked. That Yoo Joonghyuk wasn't the only one hearing this story.

"He might be okay with it, but I'm not going."

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession', begins its storytelling.]

Jung Heewon spoke in a flushed voice.

"I will never leave you behind again. If you need that star for your ending, I'll bring it."

"Heewon-ssi."

Jung Heewon approached me, fuming as if she were about to throw Lee Hyunsung away at any moment.

"I'm not joking."

I understand her heart well. Just as I try to save the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, I understand the feelings behind her words to me.

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession', gazes into you.]

Because I know that heart all too well.

"Don't worry."

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession', resonates with you.]

I must lie to her again this time.

"I won't die."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.???', activates!]

"You know who I am. I'm not doing this without thinking. So, Heewon-ssi."

Watching Jung Heewon's eyes waver before my eyes, I continued to speak.

"Please grant my request. I am fine. Please take Hyunsung-ssi and Yoosoung to a safe place. I will follow right behind."

[Incite reached its extreme. It was a skill capable of persuading anyone other than Jung Heewon. But for some reason, blood was rushing to Jung Heewon's face.]

"I—"

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession', continues its storytelling!]

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession', continues its storytelling!]

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession', continues its storytelling!]

Jung Heewon's eyes were stained with red madness. Just as the thought occurred that something was definitely going wrong, Jung Heewon's body collapsed forward with a dull thud. Yoo Joonghyuk, seizing the opening, had struck Jung Heewon in the back of the head, knocking her unconscious.

Yoo Joonghyuk immediately removed his coat and firmly tied the unconscious Shin Yoosung, Lee Hyunsung, and Jung Heewon to a spear shaft.

"This is the only time I will give in to your unreasonable demands."

Yoo Joonghyuk shouldered the spear shaft binding his comrades, turned straight toward the portal, and said.

"If you have made up your mind, make sure to bring him along."

A strange sensation tickled the corner of my heart. The Yoo Joonghyuk I knew was never the kind of person to help someone in this way. Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk had

personally stepped forward to grant my absurd demand.

In that case, it was my turn, too, to properly repay Yoo Joonghyuk's trust.

"Understood."

Yoo Joonghyuk, having moved further away, disappeared beyond the 'Bush of Missing People'. I pushed through the thick fog and approached the rift.

Oooooh—!

A fierce storm of starlight was raging inside the Golden Cage's rift. The myth-grade constellations attempting to escape the place were clashing with the might of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who stood in their way.

I forcibly threw open the rift that was about to close and shouted.

"Great Sage Heaven's Equal! Come out quickly!"

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal did not respond.

It was the result I had expected.

「The Great Sage Heaven's Equal has decided to make this 'house' his final ■■.」

But I had my own thoughts, too.

"Uh-uh."

Even in this moment of no reaction, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal must be listening to my movements, my voice, and my very existence.

This was a method I could use because I trusted the Great Sage Heaven's Equal in that way.

I shouted toward the split rift in a deliberately exaggerated voice.

"Aaaargh! It is 'Indescribable Distance'!"

Just uttering that modifier sent tingling sparks through my entire body. And that wasn't the end of it.

「'The Nameless Mist' has spotted me.」

The mere mention of that guy's modifier changed the speed at which the fog was rushing in. So, my acting was real.

"Please save me! Big Brother! I'm dying!"

I shouted as I felt the fog enveloping my feet.

"Aaaargh! I'm being devoured! Kim Dokja is dying!"

I continued to shout toward the precariously open rift.

"If you don't come, I really will die! Aaaaaaaah—!"

Before I knew it, the fog had risen to my knees. I felt the distant presence of an Outer God right behind me.

O oh oh oh oh oh oh.

The hairs on my body stood on end. A chilling sensation, one that could not be felt even from a myth-grade constellation, gripped my spine.

「I am being swallowed.」

Just as that dizzying sensation was about to engulf me, sparks flew before my eyes, and something burst forth.

[Damn you youngest bastard! I'm like that—]

Finally, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had broken through the rift in the 'Golden Sash'. His entire body was engulfed in flames like ashes. One eye was tightly closed, shedding tears. A broken leg and a severed arm. Yet, despite this, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had broken through the onslaught of myth-grade constellations to come meet me.

I spoke to him.

"Let's go together. To the final scenario."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1009 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (9)

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At that moment, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal wore an expression I had never seen before. I could see emotions swirling within his one remaining fiery golden eye. Just as he was about to open his mouth to say something, the intensity of the swirling mist around him shifted.

"Great Sage Heaven's Equal."

There is no time. I must escape from here quickly. I tried to say that. But the words would not come out.

「A void that steals away even a scream.」

Cold sweat ran down my spine. A massive shadow engulfed the area. I realized what had arrived behind me.

「An indescribable vastness.」

I had once faced 'The Nameless Mist' before. However, at that time, it was in the form of a fragment, and Master Jaehwan was with me. But Jaehwan was not here. I could not expect his absurd thrusts.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', warns you!]

[The story, 'Demon King of Salvation', warns you!]

All my stories were fiercely warning me.

「Every being standing before it scatters into mere words.」

Nevertheless, I resisted the Void with all my might. Reaching out my hand toward the staggering Great Sage Heaven's Equal, I unleashed the stories of my entire body.

[The story, 'Great King of Fear', begins its storytelling.]

I am the Great King of Fear. The one who reads all abandoned stories from the highest throne of all fears. Even if it is a 'Fear of the Apocalypse', one cannot help but bow their head before this story.

Kugugugu.

But the fog crushing me did not thin out in the slightest. I realized it anew. This disaster is not a concept measured simply by a fear rating.

This disaster is a catastrophe that even subjugated the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse'.

It was arrogance to try to fight back with a mere level like mine.

[Exclusive skill, 'Fourth Wall', activates!]

But what if it is arrogance?

[The story, 'King of Fear', continues its storytelling.]

I felt a slight sense of relief. I pulled the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's wrist with all my might.

"Let's go."

I forced out a voice, overcoming my fear. Holding onto the Great Sage's wrist, I pushed forward through the fog that was gnawing at my entire body. I felt suffocated, as if my lungs were about to shrivel, and my ears were filled with the groans of dying stars.

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

The bones and muscles of the whole body seemed to be twisted. But it moved. I'm determined not to make the Great Sage Heaven's Equal die here. That determination

dominated my body.

[Why are you doing this.]

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who was being dragged to me, said.

[You are not 'Kim Dokja', are you?]

That is true. I am not the 'Kim Dokja' that the Great Sage Heaven's Equal remembered. Nor was I the 'youngest' who had lived with him for eight years.

I am merely a reader who has read their story.

"It is something I can do even if I am not Kim Dokja."

And as that reader, I was acting as I pleased.

The desire not to lose a character I love. The desire to defy a predetermined fate.

"I do not want you to die."

In that instant, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's steps stopped. I tried to turn around. That there was no time to stop. That I had to go even one more step. I wanted to say that this fog was still gnawing away at us in real time.

But the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was not looking at me. He raised his head and stared into the Void.

[Oh, great disaster of the <Star Stream>.]

As the star shone upon the Void, the Void, too, stared back at the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

[The constellation, 'Oldest Liberator', gazes upon the 'Indescribable Vastness'.]

Receiving that gaze, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal let out a mighty lion's roar.

[The Nameless Mist.]

The moment he spoke that name directly in front of me, stories streamed down from the corners of the Great Sage's mouth. I could feel the void surging. The oppressive force of the 'Indescribable Vastness' pressing around me was intensifying. A faint dizziness arose. I could not tell what the Great Sage was trying to do.

The stories that fell from the corners of his mouth sparkled and transformed into sentences.

「He is the Monkey King of Mount Huaguo.」

「The star who faced the Heavenly Army of the Solo Emperor.」

「The one who stands at the pinnacle of all demons.」

I urgently shouted toward the Great Sage.

"Stop!"

At this rate, the Great Sage will become the target of the 'Indescribable Vastness'. That disaster will try to swallow the Great Sage Heaven's Equal first before absorbing me.

[The Nameless Mist.]

Nevertheless, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke once more.

[The Nameless Mist.]

And he spoke that name once more.

The next moment, the fog in the area writhed violently.

Kugugugugu.

A reaction that seemed to respond to the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's lion's roar. The Outer God, which was clearly nothing more than a disaster devoid of will, was answering the call of the starlight.

[Yes, have you finally answered?]

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal took something out of his bosom. It was a small gourd.

Toward the disaster staring at him, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal declared, imbuing it with his dignity.

[Suck it in, Zijin Honghuo.]

As the stopper of the gourd floated gently in the air, it opened, and along with sparks, a fog of 'indescribable vastness' swirled.

Tsutsutsutsutsu.

The fog of the surrounding area began to be sucked into the gourd.

Only then did I realize what kind of holy relic the gourd was.

If my memory serves me correctly, that relic was once used by the Golden Horn and Silver Horn King, the arch-nemesis of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

「The jar that sucks in those who respond, the Golden Red Gourd.」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal had called out the name of that dangerous Outer God three times to perform that ritual.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal smiled bitterly and said.

[It is like trying to fill a wine bottle with the ocean, but...]

A cracking sound came in real-time from the 'Golden Red Gourd' as it sucked in 'The Nameless Mist'. Cracks were forming in the relic, unable to withstand the disaster.

[We might be able to buy a little time.]

Indeed, my breathing felt slightly better than before. The feeling that the fog was blocking my movement had lessened, and above all, the swirling portal in the distance began to appear again.

I gathered my breath and activated my skill. However, the skills were simply not obeying. Neither [Way of the Wind] nor [Jeon Inhwa] activated.

[Your incarnation body is severely damaged!]

My incarnation body was corroded in many places. My joints wouldn't move well, and even though the [Fourth Wall] was activated, my skin felt hot as if I had been burned.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal was probably in the same situation. No, perhaps he was in an even more serious condition than I was.

[Let's go, youngest.]

Nevertheless, we supported each other and moved forward little by little. Stepping on the bottomless void and pushing through the thick fog, we walked slowly toward the exit.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal muttered softly.

[It's been a while since I've walked like this.]

I glanced to the side and saw that he had his eyes closed. Perhaps even opening his eyes was becoming difficult for him now.

"If you wish, I will walk with you anytime."

[Really?]

"So please don't die."

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal laughed at my words. Fragments of the story of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal scattered through that laughter.

「The Great Sage Heaven's Equal remembered the day he first saw the youngest's story.」

What were the odds that a great star would observe an incarnation from a foreign land with which it had no connection whatsoever? And what were the odds that it would patiently watch that story unfold?

[Yes, to see your story, I suppose I must live longer.]

Perhaps those words were not directed at me. They were directed at the one and only 'Kim Dokja'.

With his eyes closed, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was likely imagining Kim Dokja. He was conveying his words to the most complete form of Kim Dokja he could remember.

"Do you still want to see that story? It would be a boring story for you."

[I like stories where one deliberately walks a distance that could be covered by flying.]

In that instant, I recalled what kind of story he was the protagonist of.

He was the protagonist of 『Journey to the West』. A figure who walked a very long way to reach a world that was so far away that it could be arrived in an instant.

[There are landscapes you can only see when you are walking.]

"Just like now."

The swirling portal in the distance seemed as far away as Tianzhu. But just like Sun Wukong who eventually arrived in Tianzhu, we too will surely arrive at that portal.

"What would you like to do if you went back?"

After thinking for a moment, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal answered.

[Eating pizza and chicken with everyone would be nice.]

"Like kids?"

[Yeah, like kids.]

"Is there anything else?"

[I want to live in a big house.]

"A big house?"

[I didn't have a room of my own in that world. I wish I had a room of my own.]

I suddenly burst into laughter at the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's extremely realistic answer.

"What would you do in the room?"

[I'd read my favorite stories.]

"That sounds like something Uriel would say. Is there anything else?"

[I want to build a study in that house.]

"A study? Why?"

[There's a guy who likes books.]

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal continued speaking.

[In that world, I want to let him read the books he likes to his heart's content.]

"Is there anything else?"

After thinking for a moment, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal shook his head.

[Well. Perhaps I’ve already done enough of what I wanted to do.]

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal looked back with his eyes closed.

[I didn’t have my own room, and he couldn’t read books to his heart's content, but it was still a good home.]

Home. Suddenly, I realized what that world meant to the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

[It was a world I liked because there was a place I could walk back to.]

"We just need to walk a little further."

Supporting the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, whose strength was draining away, I struggled to take a step.

"We will be able to return home."

The swirling exit was now quite close. We can go. Just a little further, and we can escape this hell together.

It was then that a spark struck from the void.

[The 'Round Table' is urgently summoned!]

Watching the message appear before my eyes, I thought about the stars.

Stars that do not hesitate to burn themselves out to ultimately see through the story they desire.

[The constellations of the 'Round Table' roll the 'dice'.]

I heard the sound of massive probability moving.

The decision of myth-grade constellations.

The power of the Round Table was descending from the sky.

Gooooo.

Someone's palm falling from the heavens. I immediately recognized what it was.

「The Tathāgata's first finger.」

The hand of the Tathāgata, which had once crushed and sealed Sun Wukong, the 'Monkey King', was falling toward the exit we would be escaping through. The palm soon transformed into a massive mountain. Its mass and size were too great to fathom.

A colossal mountain of immeasurable size. Pushing away even the fog, the mountain plummeted toward the exit.

「Sealing Mount Five Elements.」

The intention of the 'Round Table' was clear. Even if they offered the stories of the mythical constellations, they intended to imprison us here.

[The constellation, 'Spear of the Sea', sacrifices its story!]

[The constellation, 'Flame of the South', sacrifices its story!]

[The constellation, 'Father of the One Eye', sacrifices its story!]

…

They had determined that the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who had become the 'Oldest Liberator', was a hindrance to their game of dice.

The landscape rippled as 'Stage Transformation' was activated. The very thing that had once imprisoned the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was falling right over our heads. The Great Sage tried to slow the mountain's descent by growing his Ruyi Jingu Bang, but the mountain crushed even the staff and fell toward us.

「This history cannot be defied.」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal's spell was activated. Transformed into a giant, he supported the base of the falling colossal mountain. Bearing the weight with muscles swollen to the point of bursting, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke.

[Go, my youngest.]

I shook my head. The exit was now right before my eyes. Having come this far, I could not leave him here.

[Don't worry. I will not die. You know that, don't you?]

I know. This seal cannot completely imprison the Great Sage Heaven's Equal. Now that the 'Wu Daihua' has occurred, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal will eventually escape from 'Mount Wuxing'. Just as his history has.

"But isn't that a story for 500 years from now?"

Exactly 500 years from now.

[To the stars, it is a fleeting moment.]

With a cracking sound, the 'Zizhen Hong Gu Lu' shattered. The mist escaping from the gourd began to thickly fill the surroundings.

"It is too long for me. In 500 years, no one you remember will be alive!"

[I must protect the house.]

I couldn't understand what he was saying.

"The house is already destroyed. That world cannot be protected."

The stories of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal scattered into the air. I felt uneasy. Perhaps the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had lost so many stories that he had gone insane.

[Youngest, may I call your name?]

He had opened his eyes before I knew it and was looking at me with his fiery golden eyes. Before I could even answer, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke.

[Kim Dokja.]

I hesitated, then nodded and replied.

"Yes."

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke once more.

[Kim Dokja.]

"Yes."

Like someone trying to confirm something just by calling a name, or like someone who was missing something—the Great Sage Heaven's Equal looked at me silently.

And once again, his lips moved.

[Kim Dokja.]

A sudden feeling of fear washed over me. Why? I felt like I shouldn't answer his words. Yet, meeting the eyes of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, in that instant, I had no choice but to answer.

"Yes."

Because his eyes looked so incredibly sad.

"Why are you calling me?"

At my answer, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal smiled quietly.

[I wanted to call you one last time.]

Just as I was about to ask what such a trivial reason was, a gourd sprang from the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's bosom. A gourd that looked similar to the Golden Red Gourd I had seen earlier. The moment I saw the gourd floating up, I realized what it was.

[The Holy Relic, 'Yangjiokjeongbyeong', confirms your response.]

It was the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's Holy Relic, possessing the same abilities as the 'Golden Red Gourd'.

[Suck it in, Yangjiokjeongbyeong.]

Those were the last words I had heard from the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

[NOTE 1]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Finally caught up again! T~T

# 1010 Episode 61 Prisoner of the Golden Headband (10)

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The Great Sage Heaven's Equal watched the Yangjiokjeongbyeong receding into the distance. The gourd, carried away in an instant by the torrents of the worldline. It seemed as though he could faintly hear the voice of the youngest calling out to him from within.

「'Yangjiokjeongbyeong' is a holy relic connected to the story of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.」

That gourd will flow along the torrents of the worldline toward the location where the 'Great Sage Heaven's Equal' of the 41st round resides. Since the tip of the gourd has been sealed with a fragment of the Golden Headband, the 'Indescribable Distance' will be unable to find the gourd until the youngest reaches a safe place.

Kugugugugu.

As if enraged by this fact, the surrounding fog began to attack his story hostilely.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal gathered his stories to withstand the erosion of the fog. With a cracking sound, the joints of his elbows broke.

「Mount Five Elements was crushing him.」

His story was shattered, and his incarnation body refused to obey.

「Nevertheless, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal did not give up.」

Watching the records flowing before his eyes, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke.

[You are truly diligent.]

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal knew who the recorder recording him was. As if responding to that gaze, a light spark shot up from the air.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal shook his head and said.

[Don't feel sorry. I must record everything. I know I have to.]

Watching the records flow, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal felt rather grateful. Because these records exist, he is not lonely.

Ultimately, what every star sees at the end is their own story.

With a calm heart, he looked back at the world he had lived in.

[Ahhhhh!]

The desperate struggle of the sacred flames trying to escape the world. Due to the erosion of the 'indescribable vastness', the world he wanted to protect had become a scene of pandemonium.

[Shove it! Move aside! I'm going first!]

Amidst the ruins, the story of him, the youngest, and the brothers together brushed past the tip of his nose like a lingering scent.

[The story, 'Memories of the Big House', begins its storytelling.]

Someday, someone will read this story. That is why he lives the story, and why the recorder records it. To continue the story for just a single reader, to carry on the story for his joys and sorrows, to be remembered.

「Why do stories exist in this world?」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal now knows the answer.

「Why is possessing five stories the qualification of a star?」

The stories formed in his constellation emitted a bright light. As if proving their own qualification, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal moved the stories with perfect control.

As if knowing that this might be his final stage, the stories poured out every sentence they possessed without reservation.

[The constellation, 'Oldest Liberator', reveals its full stature.]

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal rose up straight from his seat, defying the weight of Mount Five Elements. For that moment, even the mist of 'indescribable vastness' seemed to emanate from him. As if paying homage to his power, or as if waiting with satisfaction for the praise to come—the Great Sage Heaven's Equal gazed at the disaster and spoke.

[Very well, I will give you my stories. But not right now.]

His fiery golden eyes stared at the world. Soon, the true forms of myth-grade constellations, having squeezed through the rift, descended before his eyes. Terrifying constellations capable of crushing a planet with a single wave of their hand.

[Get out of the way! You damned monkey—]

The most enraged of them all was Poseidon, who had large holes in his chest and the back of his hand. Blocking the holes from which the stories were leaking, he wailed and swung his trident at the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

[No.]

A Ruyi Jingu Bang, flying in from somewhere, deflected Poseidon's trident. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal gazed at the mythical constellations standing before him and spoke.

[You cannot go anywhere.]

A total of twelve mythical constellations stood in formation before him, including Poseidon, the 'One Who Draws the Boundaries of the Seas'; Emperor Ku, the 'Fire of the South'; and Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father'.

Stars who had pioneered the giant stories of the constellations and stood at the forefront of creation myths, having ascended to the highest peaks of the heavens.

Even such stars did not readily approach the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who had burned down all his own stories to block their path.

Holding Mount Wuxing in one hand, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal stretched his other hand into the air. At that, his Ruyi Jingu Bang emitted a dazzling aura and curled into his palm.

It was Shennong, the 'Fire of the South', who spoke first to the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who had completed his readiness for battle.

[O Great Sage Heaven's Equal.]

A god, one of the Three Sovereigns of the <Emperor>, he was a star that had watched over all of the Great Sage's myths from the moment his story was born until now.

[We were once adversaries, yet it was through our adversary that the giant story could finally be born. You know this, don't you?]

The Great Sage slowly nodded.

[It was once so.]

At the sharp thorn in those words, Shennong raised his head in pity.

[I know that you have reached the throne of 'myth' in another timeline. I know that you have attained a record greater than anyone here, and thus have approached the closest place to the 'Oldest Dream'.]

[…]

[But was there a place for you to stay there?]

The Great Sage remained silent. Shennong continued speaking.

[Did the story you wandered in search of—even to the point of half-destroying the <Emperor> and throwing the Heavens into chaos—truly become your sanctuary?]

[That is—]

[In the end, you could not find a place to stay. That is why, even after reaching such a great story, you left the worldline and began to wander.]

A faint wrinkle formed between the eyebrows of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal. As if enjoying the turmoil, Shennong spoke again.

[Stars are most dazzling when they shine within the context of a nebula.]

A mysterious story flowed from the entire body of the prodigy, who carried the story of the <Emperor> on his back. It was a story that even the Great Sage Heaven's Equal could not help but be captivated by. This was because it was a story the Great Sage Heaven's Equal knew well, too.

[The giant story, 'Journey to the West', begins its storytelling.]

Through that story, he became the Monkey King, the Magic-Wielding Demon, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, and the Fighting Victorious Buddha. He came to be known as Sun Wukong.

Shen Nong spoke as if counting all that time.

[Do you not know well where your home is? The world where you were born and where your stories blossomed. That world is your home. I will say it once more. Return to 「Journey to the West」, you mischievous boy of the Heavenly Realm.]

Shennong's expression was warm as he spoke these words. His voice was deep, as if welcoming a returning child or a long-lost friend. Hearing that voice, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal smiled wryly. If he had not had 1,864 rounds of history, and thus had he not seen the youngest son and his stories, he, too, might have wavered a little upon hearing the prodigy's words.

[You dare to spout such nonsense with this damned mountain placed on my head, Shennong.]

It was because he had been lonely for too long.

[Mr. Son.]

[The place where I was born was the summit of Mount Huaguo.]

The scene of a colossal waterfall was reflected in his slowly blinking golden eyes.

[One day, while wandering Mount Huaguo, I discovered a massive waterfall.]

[… ]

[Watching the waterfall pour down like thunder, I made a bet with my companions. The one who could see inside that waterfall would become the King of Mount Huaguo.]

That was the story of the day he discovered the Water Curtain Cave on Mount Huaguo and became the Monkey King. It was a story that Shennong knew well, too.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal continued speaking, as if reciting a long memory.

[Beyond the waterfall was a cave. It was a strange yet beautiful cave. Listening to the sound of the waterfall falling endlessly, any sorrow of the world felt futile.]

The familiar scenery of the Water Curtain Cave rose in the Great Sage's eyes. There were shadows wandering through the cave. The faces of fellow monkeys whose names he had now forgotten.

[Stupid but kind monkeys lived there together. We couldn't communicate well, but I had quite a good time living there. That is, until you <Emperors> destroyed it.]

Sensing the subtle rage in the voice of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, the constellations urged Shennong on, as if on alert.

[Fire of the South, there is no time. The true nature of the disaster will soon engulf this place.]

Despite the constellations' urging, Shennong remained calm. He uttered a gentle yet powerful incantation, as if soothing the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

[Great Sage Heaven's Equal, that very desire for revenge is proof that you are still a member of our story.]

[… ]

[Come with us. And let us make that story great once again. There are many faces you will miss. The Golden Arhat and the Pure Lion are waiting for you.]

'Golden Arhat' Sha Wujing and 'Pure Lion' Zhu Bajie.

The god smiled as he watched the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's expression change in real time.

[And Shakyamuni, too—]

[Shakyamuni.]

The moment that name was heard, the expression on the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's face hardened. He looked up at the Five Elements Mountains that were pressing down on him.

The Five Elements Mountains. This mountain was the hand of the 'myth-grade constellation' he knew well.

[The fact that you have obtained this 'hand' means that Shakyamuni must have already been defeated.]

Only Shakyamuni, the master of the 'Island of the Reincarnated', could have inflicted the trials of the Five Elements Mountains upon him. However, the will contained within this mountain now did not belong to Shakyamuni.

[The nebula, <Emperor>, is moving the 'Five Elements Mountains'.]

As if to prevent him from thinking, the mountain began to press down on the Great Sage Heaven's Equal with even greater gravity. If he had still held onto the stories of 「Journey to the West」, he would not have been able to withstand this weight long ago.

[The constellation, 'Oldest Liberator', resists the stage!]

However, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal now was not merely Sun Wukong from 「Journey to the West」.

[The story, 'Kim Dokja's Brother', begins its storytelling.]

Shinnong glared in astonishment.

[That cannot be. There is no way you could resist this trial—]

Shinnong could not finish his sentence. The Ruyi Staff wielded by the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had blown off his jaw.

Sensing an ominous aura, the myth-grade constellations moved in unison, unleashing their powers.

Shinnong, having quickly restored his jaw, shouted.

[No matter how strong he is, he is alone! He cannot face all of us!]

[Although I cannot kill all of you.]

A massive amount of power began to gather in the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's Ruyi Golden Staff.

[It is possible to break every single one of your limbs.]

The myth-grade constellations turned pale upon confirming the power contained in the Ruyi Jingu Bang. They realized it instinctively.

「If you get hit by that first, you will suffer a blow close to annihilation.」

A blow that might have been easily blocked if the myth-grade constellations had joined forces.

[Dodge! Everyone, escape by any means necessary!]

[He is the one who will eventually be crushed by Mount Five Elements! There is no need to fight him!]

However, the hands of the myth-grade constellations, who deeply distrusted one another, could not possibly be in sync.

In the single moment the forces of the myth-grade constellations—who had been busy stealing the stories of their true forms and sending them out for the 41st round—dispersed, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's Ruyi Golden Staff emitted a radiant light.

Instantly expanding in volume, the Ruyi Golden Staff struck the stars with a distant trajectory that sliced through the galaxy.

Kwaaaaaaah!

A massive explosion erupted, powerful enough to cause even the falling Mount Five Elements to hesitate and rise.

[Kaaaaaah! How dare you—]

The true forms of the constellations struck by the Ruyi Staff were torn apart, suffering immense damage. Of course, that alone was not enough to kill the myth-grade constellations. But it was enough to buy time. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal drove the injured myth-grade constellations back into the rift, then sealed the entrance with the 'Golden Shackle'.

[What on earth are you doing...!]

Shennong shouted in rage. Instead of answering, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal stared at the Five Elements Mountain falling over his head.

「This is my last gift, youngest.」

He probably would not be able to witness the ending that the youngest would confirm.

But at least he could clear away a few pebbles rolling along the path to that ending.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal gazed at his crumbling world. For some reason, the scenery reminded him of Seoul, where the scenarios had begun.

[The story, 'Kim Dokja's Star', continues its storytelling.]

Recalling the day he first saw the youngest, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal spoke.

[This world is my home.]

He would be sealed in this prison.

[None of you can go outside.]

But he shall not be the only mythical constellation sealed here.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1011 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (1)

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A faint sound was heard from afar. It sounded like a heavy object being dropped, like a sturdy door closing, or like a thick book being slammed shut.

And I knew what that sound was.

「It was the sound of a universe closing.」

With an explosion of light, all the stories I knew were sucked into somewhere and turned into a single point. Beyond that point, reminiscent of a period, the screams of unwritten stars could be heard.

[The constellation, 'Spear Marking the Boundaries of the Seas', in astonishment...]

[The constellation, 'One-Eyed Father', abandoning his own story...]

[The constellation, 'Fire of the South', asking the <Emperor> for help...]

...

[The constellation, 'Oldest Liberator', gazes at you.]

The point emitting a faint light soon scattered beyond a distant vanishing point.

I reached out my hand toward that vanishing point. My hand was blocked by the smooth inner wall of the gourd and could not advance any further. A hollow and profound silence caught between my fingers.

「This was not my own emotion.」

My head was spinning. It was difficult to keep breathing. Perhaps this emotion belonged to the third Kim Dokja. Nevertheless, right now, I truly shared in the pain the third was experiencing.

[The story, 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage', grieves.]

Just by reading a story by chance, a person can feel terrible sorrow. They can sense the despair of losing a loved one, the pain of losing something precious, as if it were their own.

「Every living being capable of reading stories has been cursed.」

I opened my mouth as if speaking to the third.

"I'm sorry."

[The story, 'Prisoner of the Golden Cage', listens to your story.]

I failed to keep it again. I failed to properly keep any promise. And all that remained for me was the record.

「"Youngest."」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal knew that I was not his youngest. Nevertheless, he entrusted that role to me.

「Do I really have the qualifications to represent 'Kim Dokja'?」

As the hazy sentence became clear, the doubts I had been putting off until now surged all at once.

[Exclusive Skill, 'Fourth Wall', shakes!]

[Exclusive Skill, 'Incite'’s, influence weakens!]

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', looks at you!]

I came this far by constantly brainwashing myself. I believed I could do it. There was a reason why I had to. There were 'Dokjas' who believed in me. There were people who entrusted everything to me and watched this whole story from beyond the [Fourth Wall].

"I am."

For them, I opened my mouth once again.

"Kim Dokja."

[Exclusive Skill, 'Incite Lv.???', activated!]

I repeated [Incite], which had now become the hardest thing for me to believe in myself.

「What I learned while repeating [Incite] was that the more I repeated it, the less I was 'Kim Dokja'.」

I must act as Kim Dokja so that no one other than myself knows that fact. And thus, I must ultimately deceive even this <Star Stream>.

[Exclusive Skill, 'Fourth Wall', protects you.]

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', is satisfied with your condition.]

The fragments of stories that had been seething in my head subsided. When I opened my closed eyes again, a message was floating in the air.

—What? Are you having a self-awakening event or something?

It was my eldest brother.

"Demon King of Salvation."

I answered in a voice mixed with joy and surprise.

Is it possible to contact someone like this? I thought we could only communicate via smartphone.

—I can contact you now without the Holy Relic. We've gathered enough fragments, and the library has grown quite a bit.

Until now, contact with the 'Demon King of Salvation' was only possible through his Holy Relic, the 'smartphone'. However, it seems something changed when the third Kim

Dokja was brought inside the walls.

—So you're saying you can handle this level of probability now?

I gave a wry smile as I listened to his strangely triumphant voice.

"It doesn't sound like exactly good news. That this level of probability is allowed—"

—Right, it also means the end of the scenarios is near.

Finally, the end of the long journey was before my eyes. Although I hadn't gathered all the Kim Dokja fragments, I now had three Kim Dokjas with me.

The Demon King of Salvation.

The Great King of Fear.

And the Prisoner of the Golden Cage.

Excluding 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', I had gathered all the 'largest Kim Dokja fragments' I could collect right now.

Was it because I thought the end was near, or was my heart softened by hearing the voice of the Demon King of Salvation for the first time in a while?

My mouth opened before I knew it.

"Do you think I can do this well?"

I regretted it a little after I spat it out. Given the Demon King of Salvation's personality, it was obvious he would scold me, saying, "The ending is right around the corner, and you're still spouting such pathetic nonsense?" But...

—So what if you're not good at it?

I was slightly flustered by the answer that followed and asked back.

"Huh?"

—Kim Dokja isn't exactly the type of guy who's good at anything.

The Demon King of Salvation paused, as if deep in thought, before continuing. Through that gap in silence, the stories of Kim Dokja's life surged up.

—He's a human whose only redeeming quality, if you can call it that, is his love of reading.

With his characteristic nonchalant sarcasm, the Demon King of Salvation described Kim Dokja.

—Is that all? He's a born slacker, and his mental strength isn't particularly strong either. On the contrary, he is a guy who despairs more deeply than anyone and gets hurt more easily. He gets sad at the slightest provocation, and then rejoices like a fool.

Thinking that perhaps this wasn't entirely a story about 'Kim Dokja', I asked.

"Was it like that for you, too?"

The landscape of the universe was reflected beyond the transparent gourd. The world where the Great Sage Heaven's Equal lived was no longer visible.

Nevertheless, somewhere in that universe, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal surely exists. Sealed beneath the massive Mount Five Elements, he must be asleep, bearing the weight of all the tragedy.

—That was true.

The Demon King of Salvation answered, looking at the same universe as I did. We were looking at the same universe, yet imagining different landscapes. I was imagining the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, and as for the Demon King of Salvation.

「[You have only seen this story up to this point.]」

He must be thinking of 'Uriel'.

"How did you overcome it?"

I wanted to know. How did the Demon King of Salvation—Kim Dokja—endure the sorrow of losing Uriel in the final scenario?

—I couldn't overcome it.

"…"

—I always lost to stories.

We watched the flowing universe, the <Star Stream>, together. The final scenario was drawing near.

—Youngest.

"Yes."

—I believe you are already a sufficient 'one Kim Dokja'.

Caught off guard by those words, I bit my lip for a moment and asked back.

"Why do you think so?"

—Because only Kim Dokja can doubt the fact that he is 'Kim Dokja'.

"…"

—Because only 'Kim Dokja' will think about what 'Kim Dokja' is. In that sense, you are already an excellent Kim Dokja.

Speaking as if continuing a calm narrative, the Demon King of Salvation continued to speak.

—There might be more painful things ahead. Perhaps terrible stories are waiting for you. But there will be joyful things too. You will laugh or cry like a fool again, and get hurt.

I saw stars twinkling in the distant universe.

—And all of that becomes a story.

Without understanding why those words were comforting, I listened to him.

—No matter what anyone says, you have a story left. It’s not a Zen riddle. Look, there is a story left even now.

Only then did I look around. The contents of the gourd came into much clearer view belatedly. The Demon King of Salvation was right.

I was the only one here, but strictly speaking, I was not alone.

[The story fragment, 'Time to Brush Teeth', begins its storytelling.]

At first, I thought it was dust. But when I looked closely...

[The story fragment, 'Memory of a Failed Omurice', begins its storytelling.]

It was someone's hair.

[The story fragment, 'Special Push-up Training', begins its storytelling.]

With my mouth agape in a daze, I gazed at the scene where golden hairs were scattering like snow.

Then, at a certain moment, a strand of hair touching my fingertips stirred up a small cloud of dust with a 'pop'. Soon after, I felt something stick firmly to my shoulder.

There stood a baby monkey.

A tiny baby monkey, reminiscent of little Kim Dokja.

"Great Sage Heaven's Equal."

As I called his name, the baby monkeys gathered around me as if in response. As story fragments gathered in one place, a warm, cozy atmosphere enveloped the area.

「And all of that becomes a story.」

The memories the Great Sage Heaven's Equal cherished were here.

The next moment, one of the baby monkeys lingering nearby lightly grasped my hand.

「[Is there the youngest in that world, too?]」

The moment I heard that familiar voice, I felt dizzy. It felt as if I had met the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's eyes. An old memory surfaced in my mind.

「[The constellation, 'Oldest Liberator', gazes upon you.]」

I was certain I had seen that message sometime before. It was on the day I had analyzed a large volume of hair on the 'Scales of Settlement'.

I hurriedly checked the name of the story fragment that had grabbed me.

[Story fragment, 'Encounter with the Wenny King', begins its storytelling.]

Only then did everything feel like it made sense.

This was the memory of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

On the day I felt the Great Sage's gaze through the 'Scales of Settlement', the Great Sage had indeed gone to meet the Wenny King.

「【How is it. The 'Kim Dokja' of that world.】」

The Great Sage retorted in a sharp voice toward the strangely cocky Wenny King.

「[What ultimately happens to the end of that world? What is contained within this '■■ of all stories'?]」

Unlike me, who had carefully chosen my questions, the Great Sage spat them out without hesitation.

「[You arrogant fool, surely you can see something. Or not?]」

The Wenny King smiled wryly, finding the Great Sage Heaven's Equal amusing, and opened his mouth.

「【Shining star, you cannot see the '■■ of all stories'. It is a landscape not permitted to you. Don't you already know this?】」

At the Wenny King's question, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal nodded after a brief silence.

「【Then it is time to ask the real reason you sought me out.】」

The Wenny King spread his arms wide like an actor performing an exaggerated act. His arms creaked and moved like a scale. As if trying to measure the value of the star right before his eyes.

「【I ask, Great Star. What are you curious about that you have come here, staking your entire story?】」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal glanced at the Wenny King, then stared once again at me beyond the scales.

「['The One and Only Kim Dokja.']」

He asked in a clear and distinct voice.

「[Is that 'a story that truly exists'?]」

[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 1012 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (2)

The Wenny King had no answer even after hearing the question from the Great Sage Heaven's Equal. Like a human counting the stars, he examined the story fragment floating around him for a long time before asking back.

「【Do you not already know the answer?】」

The Wenny King spoke as if amused by the fact that none other than the Great Sage Heaven's Equal had asked that question.

「【Because you, too, are a being capable of using 'clones'.】」

Even without Han Sooyoung's exclusive skill [Avatar], there were several ways to split a body in the <Star Stream>.

For example, stars that had lived for a long time could split their stories to form temporary avatar bodies, and there were also those like the Great Sage Heaven's Equal who created 'clones' by breathing stories into fragments of their avatar bodies.

「【Just because you injected a part of the story into your 'clone', can you say that you are no longer the 'Great Sage Heaven's Equal'?】」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal shook his head. Then the Wenny King spoke.

「【Yes. Usually, people don't bother to question that. Just because they lost some story, they don't say things like 'they are no longer 100 percent'. Do you know why that is?】」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal thought for a moment and replied.

「[Because we are always losing stories.]」

The Wenny King nodded, smiling as if satisfied with the answer.

「【You are right. Every being lives while gradually losing the stories they possess. If we assume that a state where all stories are intact is '100 percent', then we are essentially always moving toward a state that is not '100 percent'.】」

「[…]」

「【Therefore, your question must start again from here. What exactly is the 'One and Only Kim Dokja'? If that is what '100% Kim Dokja' means, then what exactly is the definition of '100%'?】」

Which Kim Dokja can be called '100% Kim Dokja'?

「【Existences lose stories over time, but they also gain more. In particular, beings who actively live out the scenario gain more stories as time passes. In other words—】」

「[The total amount of 100% might continue to grow over time.]」

「【What point in time do you think can serve as the standard for '100%'? The point in time when he possessed the most memories? Or, the point in time when he was most loved by the stars?】」

When the Great Sage Heaven's Equal could not answer easily, the Wenny King spoke again.

「【It is the same even if you define '100%' based on a specific point in time. For instance, let us assume that Kim Dokja 'just before being split into fragments' is '100 percent'—that is, the 'complete form'.】」

The Wenny King floated a small balance scale in the air and placed a weight on one of the plates. The scale's arms slowly tilted. The Wenny King placed another weight on the opposite, tilted plate.

「【Then what about the 'Kim Dokja' from before that?】」

The scale tilted again.

「【Is the other Kim Dokja who did not reach that time 'incomplete'? Is the 'Kim Dokja' who started the scenarios not '100 percent' at that point?】」

Watching the scale swing back and forth, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal pondered deeply.

Which 'Kim Dokja' could be called '100 percent'? Even he, who had lived for a long time, could not know the answer to the question. And according to his wisdom, in such cases, the problem usually did not lie in the 'answer'.

「[Was that the wrong question?]」

The Wenny King smiled faintly. Only then did the Great Sage Heaven's Equal understand what the Wenny King was trying to convey. In the end, the Wenny King was spending a long time explaining just a single sentence to him.

「【Only those who love the 'Oldest Dream' obsess over that concept of '100 percent'. It is likely a desire to fully reclaim the starlight they once loved.】」

「[So, it means it is impossible in the end.]」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal knew it, too. That the concept of '100 percent Kim Dokja' was nothing more than a delusion created by those who loved him too much.

Nevertheless, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal could not blame those who wandered in search of such a Kim Dokja. It was because he, too, understood their feelings.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal recalled the faces he had missed for the first time in a while. <Kim Dokja Company>, which had chosen a different ending from him.

The beings who had seen the end of the world alongside the 'Oldest Dream'.

「【It’s impossible… I never said that.】」

Perhaps it was because he had been thinking too deeply about them. For a moment, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal did not understand the words of the Wenny King.

「[What did you just say?]」

The Wenny King smirked as he watched the Great Sage Heaven's Equal’s fiery golden eyes waver.

「【Even after living for so long, your imagination is still lacking. Do you think that 'impossible stories' exist in this <Star Stream>?】」

「[Didn't you explain it that way until now?]」

「【That is what I mean if you explain it logically. But as you and I both know, this <Star Stream> is not constructed so coherently.】」

The Wenny King tapped the fragments of stories floating in the air. The true story he had just touched was a story that the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was also aware of.

「"Let's go with the third method."」

Faced with impossible scenarios, Kim Dokja had always pursued the 'third method' that no one else chose.

The stars felt jealousy, cheered, and went wild as they watched Kim Dokja survive the brink of death time and time again. Kim Dokja had always lived such an impossible story.

If this world had been that coherent, those stories could not even exist.

「【If the 'Oldest Dream' wishes to dream, that dream will surely find a way to be realized. Even if it is a 'square circle'.】」

「[What is that 'way'? How is a single 'Kim Dokja' created?]」

「【That story is already being realized. Because those who love him desire that story, the 'Oldest Dream' has also begun to dream it. All you and I can do is simply watch it.】」

Just watching.

With that expression, the Wenny King had effectively issued a sort of expulsion order. It meant that even he, who occupies the highest place in the skies of this world, and the Great Sage Heaven's Equal could only watch, so unnecessary questions should stop.

However, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal did not back down. He brought up an important question that he had kept hidden until now.

「[Does the 'Very Giant Baby' want that story too?]」

The moment I heard that question, I was startled.

A Very Giant Baby.

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal also knew of the being that Han Sooyoung had told me about once, and the one I had asked the Wenny King about.

「[I know that such a being exists behind the name of the 'Oldest Dream'.]」

Unlike me, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal did not hesitate for the slightest to ask about that being.

「[I want to know about that being. Tell me everything you know.]」

Sometime ago, during a conversation with me, the Wenny King had proposed a deal. He asked that if I ever reached the place where the 'Very Giant Baby' was, I should tell him about the scenery as well.

「【That answer cannot be found even if you count all your stories.】」

His attitude was strangely different from when he spoke with me. For a moment, I felt a sense of doubt. Perhaps the 'Wenny King' knows more about the 'very giant baby' than he told me.

「【Because what you are curious about is the cause and the 'result' of all these stories.】」

The cause and the result of all these stories.

Until now, the only being that fit such an explanation was the 'Oldest Dream'.

The Wenny King, who had been gazing into the blazing golden eyes of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, let out a light sigh and added.

「【All I can show you is the 'process'. If that is acceptable, I will show it to you.】」

「[What is the price?]」

「【Give me the story you wish to give.】」

The Great Sage Heaven's Equal pondered for a moment, then took out a fragment of a story from his bosom. It was a fragment so broken that even its name was hazy. Nevertheless, the fragment of the story in the hands of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was chattering about something.

「"■■, we can ■■ the world."」

The Wenny King looked closely at the story and smiled.

「【It is an interesting story. Let's make a deal.】」

I recalled seeing that story at the 'Wenny King's' hideout. Was that why the Wenny King possessed it?

「【Here, this is—】」

The Wenny King took the story from the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and gave him the story he wanted.

「【It is the process of heading toward the '■■■'s Deep Sea.】」

Strangely enough, at that moment, the Wenny King's words reached my ears clearly, without any filtering.

A moment later, the story emitting a white light on the Wenny King's palm began to tell its story.

It was...

「Thus, the 'Deceiver of the Stars' finally reached the reward of the scenarios.」

A story about Kim Dokja, whom I, too, know well.

「"Your name is Kim Dokja."」

---

Few people remember the moment they were born.

This is because the 'first memory' is always the 'memory that is erased first'.

A memory from a time when one cannot even perceive what 'memory' is. A scene that melts away first, like the first snowflakes to fall.

「He remembered the moment he was born.」

The first thing he saw after being born was a clear white sky.

A snowfield where cold snowflakes were scattering.

With that snowfield as a backdrop, someone was looking at him.

"Your name is Kim Dokja."

It was a blonde man with narrowed eyes.

「In the pure white snowfield, he met his father.」

The memory of that time was both vivid and hazy. Perhaps it was because of the endlessly pouring snow.

A snowstorm falling endlessly. As he recalled that blizzard, Kim Dokja thought of the massive manuscript paper.

"What is that?"

"It is a story."

The act of writing down unknown words one by one on a huge, desolate piece of manuscript paper.

His childhood was a process of realizing that every story scattered across the world had its own unique shape.

"What is a story?"

"Shall I call it a story?"

In that world, there were many stories to teach him. Kim Dokja could read those stories simply by opening his eyes wide.

「"Save me! Aaaargh!"」

Kim Dokja ran through the falling story fragments with his arms outstretched and his mouth agape.

「"Kill them all. Do not spare a single one. I will swear by my modifier and annihilate their nebula."」

Some stories were eerie.

「"No matter what happens, I will not let my incarnation die."」

Some stories were solemn.

「"Why, why on earth must we go through such things? Oh God."」

And most stories were unkind to the young boy. Whenever he encountered something he didn't know, Kim Dokja asked his father. Fortunately, his father was patient and always answered his questions kindly.

"That character needs a reason not to blame his own weakness. He wants to believe that the reason for his failure lies not with him. That is why he seeks God."

"So, in the end, it all happened because that person was weak?"

"Some stories are created that way."

After listening to a long explanation, Kim Dokja felt hungry.

Yawning lightly, Kim Dokja stared blankly at the pile of stories lying on the floor and asked.

"Can I eat this?"

At that, his father nodded and said as if he found it quite amusing.

"If you want, go ahead and try it."

"You eat some, too."

"It’s not really my taste, though..."

The father and son sat side by side, scooping up snow. The taste of story fragments crumbling in their teeth. Some stories were sweet, others were sad. Without understanding why they were sweet or sad, Kim Dokja said,

"Is it delicious?"

"I don't know."

His father smiled faintly, as if he enjoyed watching Kim Dokja scoop up snow.

Kim Dokja looked at his father for a moment and then asked,

"What is your name, Father?"

"It is Cheon Inho."

"Cheon-ssi?"

"Yes."

"I'm a Kim-ssi, you know."

"That's right."

Watching his father answer without much thought, Kim Dokja tilted his head.

"That's strange."

At Kim Dokja's question, his father paused for a moment and asked,

"Did you realize that it is strange?"

Kim Dokja looked up at his father with a slightly sulky gaze and asked,

"Why did you name me Kim Dokja?"

Kim Dokja knew that his father was a clever man. Although he always viewed the world through squinting eyes, through that narrow gap, he understood the world more accurately than anyone else.

That is why Father never hesitated when answering questions.

"Hmm."

For the first time, Father, who had always been like that, was engrossed in his answer. His expression was as if he were contemplating whether or not he should tell him that answer.

Just as Kim Dokja had eaten another handful of story fragment, Father opened his mouth in a low voice.

"That is the protagonist's name."

"What is a protagonist?"

Father swept the story fragment scattered on the floor with his large hand. As the fragments, which had been continuing their stories here and there, crumbled under his touch, a clean blank space soon stood out.

Father took his hand and began to write a name on the blank space.

「Kim」

Watching the name being written one character at a time, Kim Dokja felt a little scared. Father held his small hand and continued to write the name.

「Dok」

With each character written, the sound of the swept-away fragments wailing could be heard. Kim Dokja instinctively tried to pull his hand away. But Father pulled his hand with even greater force and completed the name.

「ja」

The name was finally complete.

He looked at the name with his father. Strangely, the cries of the stories, which had been so loud until the end of the war, could no longer be heard.

"He is the only being worthy of being recorded in this world."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1013 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (3)

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On the terrifyingly silent snowfield, Kim Dokja read the name over and over again.

Kim Dokja. As he muttered the name unconsciously, his father nodded.

"That is your name."

My name. Kim Dokja repeated the lingering resonance contained within that name time and time again. Then, the name, which had felt unfamiliar at first, gradually began to feel like his own.

Kim Dokja. That is his name.

"But isn't it possible to be recorded even if you aren't the protagonist?"

Kim Dokja said, looking up at the snow scattering in the air. A blizzard of fragments of snow stories raging in real time.

Some records were short, and some were long. Yet, they were all recorded there. Someone's misfortune, someone's sorrow, their joys and sorrows—they were all written evenly, without any bias.

Some stories were interesting, and others were boring, but nevertheless, the stories were fair to everyone.

That was the case until he heard his father's story.

"It is different."

Snow piled up again upon Kim Dokja's name. Watching the snow thickly cover the place, obscuring even the fact that a name existed there, his father rose from his seat.

"All these stories ultimately contribute to a single story."

"All these stories?"

"Yes."

It was unbelievable.

"Someone's sorrow, joy, passion, and hardship. Even life and death. They all exist to complete a single, perfect story."

"Is that the 'protagonist's' story?"

"Yes."

All this snow is falling for just one person.

"That is."

As he slowly closed his eyes, the falling snowflakes touched Kim Dokja's cheek.

"It is sweet."

The snowflakes were speaking. The protagonist's name is in all those stories. Every story exists to complete the protagonist's story.

To Kim Dokja, those words sounded as follows.

「The protagonist is not lonely.」

In the midst of that comforting realization, Kim Dokja suddenly opened his eyes. His father was looking somewhere with his back turned.

What could he be looking at? His father's back looked even smaller than usual. As he reached out and touched his back, a story that had flowed down from it landed on his fingertips. Kim Dokja read the story.

「There was a man there.」

The figure in the story was not his father. Black hair. A man with a jet-black coat fluttering in the wind was there. A man who surveyed the world with his characteristically piercing gaze.

Kim Dokja stared blankly at his story and spoke.

"This person is..."

Father, noticing what story Kim Dokja was looking at, suddenly turned around. Then, snatching the story from Kim Dokja's hand, he said.

"It is the protagonist."

"There is another protagonist?"

Father paused for a moment, then nodded.

"Because that is a different 'story'."

The protagonist of another story.

Kim Dokja slowly blinked his eyes and recalled that man.

"He looked lonely."

His father gave no answer to Kim Dokja's words.

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Eating the snow falling from the sky, Kim Dokja eventually came to be able to distinguish its taste. Which was sweet and which was bitter.

He also learned what was polite and which was rude (it was around this time that Kim Dokja began to use honorifics).

He also learned about good and evil and morality. These were all things taught by stories.

He grew up reading countless stories over and over again. In the process, he even developed a favorite.

「"Dokja-ssi."」

Among them, the story Kim Dokja liked the most was—as expected, the story about him.

「"Dokja-ssi! No! Dokja-ssi!"」

Watching the figure in the story call out to Kim Dokja, he felt an inexplicable emotion.

The story was damaged in many places, so the names of those calling him could not be read clearly. Nevertheless, they were clearly calling him and saying the exact same words.

「"No! Kim Dokja!"」

"Why do these people always say it can't be done?"

"Because you have committed many acts you shouldn't have."

It felt somewhat infuriating. It was like being belatedly asked for a bill for a mistake long forgotten.

「"Dokja-ssi!"」

Kim Dokja read the passage where people called his name over and over again. Then he asked.

"But wasn't it all done for those people?"

"Do you think so?"

"In the end, it seems like I saved their lives."

In the story, Kim Dokja risked his own life time and time again to save the lives of others, not his own.

Nodding his head in agreement, his father said,

"From that perspective, you are right."

"Isn't that so?"

"Therefore, they must keep their heads down and thank you until they die."

"But why do these people seem to resent me?"

"Is it written that way?"

"No."

There was no description in any record that the group resented Kim Dokja. Nevertheless Kim Dokja felt that way. In the story, they were clearly resentful of him.

"That is a feeling that is very difficult for me to explain."

"Explain it to me. Father, you know everything."

"It’s not that I know everything. Especially when it comes to them."

<Kim Dokja Company>, that is what the story called them.

After thinking for a moment, Kim Dokja spoke again.

"These people, their group name is <Kim Dokja Company>, so why do they treat Kim Dokja so roughly?"

"…"

"It feels unfair. They only think about mistreating and restricting the person who went to such lengths to save them whenever they get the chance."

Father asked, admiring the idea as if it were incredibly fresh.

"Do you think that is unfair?"

"Yes. Because I am Kim Dokja, too. Kim Dokja should be the one to get angry about Kim Dokja's affairs!"

"In my opinion, that isn't 'that' unfair."

"Why? I even risked my life?"

"You were someone who liked risking your life."

After thinking for a moment, Kim Dokja shook his head as if to say that couldn't possibly be true.

"Where would you find someone like that?"

"That is exactly the problem."

"What?"

"Life is precious to everyone. Yet you risked it recklessly."

"It's my life, so what? I risked my own life to save them, so why—"

"They."

His father's squinting eyes parted slightly. Feeling his father's emotions seeping through the gaps, Kim Dokja listened to his father's words.

"Because they loved you."

Love. Kim Dokja stared blankly down at the story he had just read. He saw the Kim Dokja within the story and <Kim Dokja Company>.

Why? After hearing that word, every story he had read felt different.

Swallowing a slight tremor, Kim Dokja asked.

"What is love?"

His father fell into thought once again. Watching his father immerse himself in thought for quite a long time, Kim Dokja thought that perhaps his father didn't know what 'love' was.

"It means I like all your stories."

I like all your stories. Even with his father's explanation, Kim Dokja could hardly grasp the meaning of those words.

"Father, do you love me too?"

"No, I am just someone who uses you."

"Use? How?"

"I hope you grow up strong enough to fulfill my dream."

"What is your dream, Father?"

"To become the protagonist."

Kim Dokja stared blankly, his mouth agape.

"Is that true?"

"Yes, it is."

"Is Father perhaps a bad person?"

"I like your honest sentiment. Please continue to be that honest."

Kim Dokja continued reading the story. The story of Kim Dokja and <Kim Dokja Company>. 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』.

"Does father appear in this story?"

"Yes, he does."

"Where?"

His father flipped through the story fragments he had been reading and pointed to a passage.

"Here."

Kim Dokja began to read the passage he had pointed to. It was a passage he had read before. However, it was a section he hadn't examined closely because he had read through it so quickly. His father was alive within the story of that passage.

"Was this father?"

When Kim Dokja asked back in disbelief, his father replied with a sour expression.

"Yes, it is."

"Wow, he appears really pathetic."

"Saying things like that in front of the person involved is bound to hurt them."

The father in the story was a villain. Not a great villain, but just a petty one. He was the ruler of a small station, and after inciting the people there, he was killed by Kim Dokja and his group.

"He died a very cruel death."

Watching Kim Dokja read the account of the death with such interest, his father asked.

"Do you feel sorry for your father?"

"I do."

Kim Dokja pondered the meaning of those words carefully before answering.

"A little bit."

"Then please avenge me."

"How do I do that?"

"Beat the people who killed me."

"You mean Kim Dokja and Kim Dokja Company?"

His father nodded.

"Don't you hate them? It is they who brutally killed me, and it is they who made you exist here in loneliness. In the end, it is all them."

Now, Kim Dokja knew what that meant. He had heard it all from his father.

That he was a part of 'Kim Dokja'. And that, as a result of <Kim Dokja Company> trying to reclaim him, he had been shattered into pieces and fallen into this snowfield.

"They even brutally killed your only father."

"Strictly speaking, that is the father from a different timeline."

"Don't you feel sorry for the version of me from that other timeline?"

"That is because the father from that other timeline did something wrong. And—"

Kim Dokja spoke, quietly tracing the scene of himself shattering into fragments with his hand.

"If it weren't for them, I wouldn't have even been born."

"… "

"Besides, I probably wouldn't even get to meet father."

At those words, his father smiled faintly and said,

"You're definitely not cut out to be a villain."

"Were you trying to make me a villain?"

"I intended to make you the protagonist."

"How can I become the protagonist?"

At that question, his father fell into deep thought once again. This time, it was truly deep thought. Watching his father's expression, Kim Dokja realized.

「He does not know the answer.」

Perhaps it was because he was excited by the fact that he had asked a question his father didn't know for the first time. Kim Dokja let out a grunt and lay down on the floor. Feeling the cold snow gently envelop his entire body, Kim Dokja opened his mouth like a fool. A soft snowflake fell onto the tip of his tongue.

His father, who had been quietly looking down at Kim Dokja, also sat down beside him.

"Can't we just keep living like this?"

Savoring the endlessly falling snowflakes and the stories contained within them, Kim Dokja slowly blinked his eyes.

"Here, if you just open your mouth wide like this, food falls from the sky."

"That isn't meant to be eaten."

"But."

"This isn't a proper life either."

"If it isn't a proper life, does that mean we shouldn't live?"

"Such words are meaningful only when spoken by someone who knows what a proper life is."

At his father's words, Kim Dokja puffed out his cheeks and moved his limbs. As he did so, marks were left in the snow exactly in the shape of his small limbs.

"I'm really fine living here with just you and me, Father."

A long breath escaped his father's lips once again. The breath turned into small fragments of stories and scattered quietly.

"Are you glad you met me?"

"I like it."

"Even though your father is just a petty villain?"

"Not here."

"Aren't you unhappy?"

"Why would I be unhappy?"

"Because you are the son of a villain."

"It’s fine."

"You are unhappy."

"Why?"

"Because you don't realize that you are unhappy."

Kim Dokja tilted his head.

"I am not unhappy."

His father said nothing more. Perhaps because the silence felt awkward, Kim Dokja spoke.

"Tell me a little about yourself."

"What do you mean?"

"Just the story of your life."

It struck him anew that he had never once heard a proper story about his father.

"It’s a story of nothing special."

"That’s fine, though."

His father thought for a moment, then slowly began to speak.

"I lived my life with the goal of surpassing one man."

"Who is that?"

Perhaps because of the meaningful opening, Kim Dokja's heart pounded strangely. His father's lips slowly parted.

"The name of that man is."

Looking back long after, his father might have known it at that very moment. The moment he reveals that name, Kim Dokja will remember it forever.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

And Kim Dokja, having learned that name, will one day inevitably—

"It is the Supreme King, Yoo Joonghyuk."

That he will want to go outside this 'snowfield'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1014 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (4)

"Yoo Joonghyuk. It's the person you showed me before, right?"

Father smiled faintly at Kim Dokja's quick-witted question.

"Did you know?"

"I had a feeling it might be him."

The man with the piercing eyes and a pitch-black coat who had appeared in Father's story sometime ago. Kim Dokja vividly remembered the man's appearance.

"Well, he is a man hard to forget once you see him."

"That was the first time you took away a story to prevent me from reading it, Father."

"Because back then you weren't used to stories yet."

Kim Dokja tilted his head for a moment and asked.

"What does that have to do with anything?"

"Because if you start reading that man's story, you'll end up reading only that one."

"Why?"

"That is just how a protagonist's story is."

The protagonist. Father had certainly called him the protagonist last time as well.

"I've seen that person in other stories, too."

"Of course. He is the protagonist."

"Then do the stories of this universe exist for the sake of that person?"

Father had clearly said so. That, ultimately, all the stories of this world exist to complete the protagonist's story.

"That is correct."

"But he looked lonely."

"He is someone who wants to be lonely."

Someone who wants to be lonely.

Kim Dokja tilted his head once again.

"Where is there such a person?"

"There are people like that."

Father's words sounded as strange as the explanation that 'there are people who like to risk their lives', but Kim Dokja made an effort not to argue back.

There are still many stories in this world that he does not understand, and perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk's story is of that kind as well.

So, instead of asking questions, Kim Dokja read Yoo Joonghyuk's story. True to his nature as a protagonist, the man appeared in every corner of the stories scattered throughout the universe. His name was even in the story he liked the most.

「"Yoo Joonghyuk!"」

In that story, his name was called as often as Kim Dokja's. A cry filled with worry and anxiety, or perhaps an unknown hope. His name was always shrouded in emotions of that

color.

"Were you acquainted?"

"In a certain world, yes."

"Were you friends?"

"We were comrades who lived and died separately."

"Separately? Not together?"

A playful smile appeared on his father's face.

"That is correct."

Does that mean they weren't very close? Then again, looking at the story, he thought that might be the case. After all, in the stories he had read, Kim Dokja usually looked at Yoo Joonghyuk with a look of exasperation or called him by adding retorts like, "You bastard!"

"What was his relationship with father?"

"He had nothing to do with me."

"That may be true in the <Kim Dokja Company> story, but it's different in your story, Father."

Father's eyes widened as if he had learned something like that.

"It seems you are reading stories quite diligently."

"Because that is the only thing I have to do here."

"Yoo Joonghyuk was my rival."

Kim Dokja's eyes widened at the unexpected word that came from his father's mouth.

"A rival?"

"Yes."

"It's not just in your imagination, is it?"

"I fought life-or-death battles with him several times. We nearly killed each other, and nearly died again."

"Do you miss him?"

"…"

"It feels just like you are talking about an old friend."

Father was silent for a moment, then smiled bitterly. Kim Dokja was slightly surprised, as it was the first time he had seen his father smile like that.

Father continued.

"I killed him with my own hands."

"…"

"I saw with my own eyes the moment he breathed his last and left this world."

His father looked somewhat hollow as he told this story.

Kim Dokja hesitated for a moment before asking.

"You said your life's goal was to surpass that man, didn't you?"

"That is correct."

"Then you achieved the goal you wanted, Father."

His father did not answer with a simple 'Yes' as usual. Kim Dokja asked again.

"Weren't you happy?"

"He left me behind and moved on to the 'next story'."

A voice like an indifferent period. Kim Dokja realized, a little late, what his father meant.

It was an explanation regarding Yoo Joonghyuk's ability, [Regression].

「For Yoo Joonghyuk, death is merely the end of a short chapter.」

"In his long journey to prevent the destruction of the world, I was merely a minor villain decorating a single episode. The residue left behind in a world abandoned by the protagonist. That is me."

Kim Dokja was flustered. The stories he had read had never taught him what to say in a situation like this.

So, Kim Dokja had to think for himself. He had to do his best with his small head to ponder how to comfort the villain alienated from the protagonist's story.

"No one likes stories like that."

Born as a character in a story, destined to live a story receiving no one's love. Kim Dokja thought about that fate for a long time.

The man who survived alone to the very end in a world abandoned by the protagonist, finally arriving at this snowfield. He thought and thought about the father who found him —about the man named 'Cheon Inho'. And he reached a conclusion.

"I like it."

At Kim Dokja's words, Cheon Inho's shoulders trembled slightly.

"Wouldn't it be okay for at least one story in the world to exist where a villain who worked incredibly hard defeats the protagonist?"

"…"

"Father did his best. I know that. How much effort you put into that story, and how hard you tried to make it shine alongside the protagonist."

Cheon Inho stared blankly at his son. No constellation had ever spoken to him in that way.

"Even if it isn't the protagonist, every character is worth recording."

As young Kim Dokja spoke those words, his eyes shone like stars. Starlight illuminating the forgotten in the blank spaces of a story that no one remembers.

「Perhaps he came all the way to this snowfield to confirm the existence of this light.」

Watching his son chatter away to comfort him, Cheon Inho slowly opened his mouth.

"Let's read a particularly interesting story today."

"A particularly interesting story?"

Stories were falling from the sky. Stories so vast that it seemed impossible to finish reading them even in a lifetime. Fortunately, Cheon Inho knew a few of those stories that were quite intriguing.

"It is a story about a man who eats dirt."

---

Time in the snowfield continued to flow. A week, a month, a year, ten years. Like snow. Welcoming the falling stories and reading them, Kim Dokja lived on with Cheon Inho.

"Here, here is a true story that fell today."

"Thank you."

"Have you finished organizing them?"

"Roughly enough."

"But why did you set this one aside?"

"It's a story about a kid who eats dirt."

As time passed, Kim Dokja found more stories he wanted to read.

「"Dokja-ssi."」

Most of them were true stories about <Kim Dokja Company>. Stories about people wandering in search of him, who had disappeared from this universe.

"But I don't understand this part."

"This part."

However, most of the stories falling on the snowfields were not intact, so the two often had to put their heads together to study them.

"How about interpreting it like this?"

A faint light flowed from Cheon Inho's fingertips and mended the broken stories.

「While spending time with Kim Dokja in the snowfield, Cheon Inho acquired a new ability.」

Power to handle stories and fill in the blank spaces.

The ability to revise [Fate].

「Cheon Inho became a 'Recorder of Fear'.」

With that power, Cheon Inho joined forces with Kim Dokja to excavate the stories scattered within the ruins and began to piece them together.

"Or, this interpretation is also possible."

Watching Kim Dokja rejoice at the continuing stories, and feeling unfamiliar with himself for unconsciously smiling at him, Cheon Inho continued to gather stories again and again.

「Thus, in a place unknown to anyone, a new 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』 was being completed.」

A single being is the totality of the records he read. Cheon Inho felt, in real time, Kim Dokja becoming Kim Dokja.

As they read the lost stories together and reread them, the number of questions Kim Dokja asked gradually decreased. Instead, the time he spent gazing somewhere with longing eyes increased. Cheon Inho felt he knew what Kim Dokja was missing, but he didn't specifically ask about it.

"So this is how it turned out."

Reading the latter part of the undone narrative, Kim Dokja sighed or his sorrows grew. In particular, there was a story he watched repeatedly. It was the scene where '49% of Kim Dokja' was being lifted.

「"If this is the story you wanted..."」

Kim Dokja, who wanted to be with <Kim Dokja Company> but ultimately could not possess that story.

"My comrades."

Now, that Kim Dokja was reminiscing about them within the restored records.

"Do they know I am here?"

"…"

"If Han Sooyoung had written this story, and if the imaginations of the fragments of Kim Dokja scattered throughout the universe had gathered to bring about the miracle of the 'Kim Dokja' they remembered returning—"

Watching the endlessly falling snow, Kim Dokja continued to ask.

"Why am I still here?"

Why could the Kim Dokja of this place not return to <Kim Dokja Company>?

Cheon Inho could not answer. It was a question he could not understand.

「Everything is already recorded, and simultaneously, it is being recorded.」

Recalling that sentence, Cheon Inho slowly opened his mouth.

"Do you want to meet <Kim Dokja Company> again?"

Kim Dokja's ethereal eyes blinked.

"If I want to meet them?"

"You just need to leave this world."

"How?"

"That is..."

Cheon Inho said, gazing at the landscape of the snowfield he had seen for so long.

"I don't know either."

A vast snowfield with no discernible entrance or exit. They had been trapped here for over a decade.

After a moment of silence, Kim Dokja asked.

"What about you, Father? Do you want to go outside?"

Cheon Inho thought. Clearly, he had something he wanted to say.

"I wanted to go outside."

He wanted to be the protagonist. He wanted to be recorded alongside Yoo Joonghyuk, in his own ending.

"Until recently, that is."

Nevertheless, while staying in this snowfield with Kim Dokja, that desire gradually faded. Perhaps it was because he had become accustomed to this life.

"Lately, I often think that I don't necessarily have to go outside."

Cheon Inho felt unfamiliar with himself for saying those words. It was because it was a statement that denied the entire history he had lived until now. Cheon Inho forced a wry smile without realizing it.

"I just mean that I am like that. You..."

Thinking he had said something unnecessary, he turned his head, but Kim Dokja's condition seemed somewhat normal. Kim Dokja wasn't listening to him. To be precise, he was in a state where he couldn't hear.

"How."

With Kim Dokja and his voice a mixture of intense emotion, Cheon Inho gazed at the story that had settled on Kim Dokja's fingertips.

"How is a story like this—how is that possible?"

Kim Dokja was reading the story. It was a story he, too, had never seen before.

"How does a 'Kim Dokja' like this exist?"

Reading the story together, Cheon Inho sighed.

「Until that story appeared, there were only two Kim Dokjas in this world.」

The Kim Dokja chosen by the group, and the Kim Dokja left behind in the snowfield.

「If I could be reborn, I hope at least I won't be Kim Dokja.」

And on that day, Snowfield Kim Dokja.

「"Lee Hakhyun, your name is Lee Hakhyun."」

He came to realize the existence of a brother who was not yet known.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1015 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (5)

Since that day, Kim Dokja read the brother's stories every day.

"What are they eating?"

Cheon Inho came looking for the brother's story fragments every day and read them with Kim Dokja.

"They are cherry tomatoes."

"But Kim Dokja hates tomatoes."

"That friend isn't Kim Dokja, is he?"

Kim Dokja seemed pleased with Cheon Inho's answer; he kept nodding and continued reading the stories.

「...And so, Lee Hakhyun thought…」

The story fragments Cheon Inho brought were mostly trivial. An everyday life without scenarios, constellations, or monsters. Within that, his brother—who was once Kim Dokja—now with a different name, lived his life steadily.

He grew up in an ordinary family, crying and laughing, supported by his affectionate parents. He celebrated his birthday with congratulations from a few friends, entered elementary school, and then entered middle school.

"He entered a writing contest."

In the world of the brothers, there was no 'Ways of Survival'. It was a world where 'Ways of Survival' was unnecessary from the start. This was because the tragedy that befell Kim Dokja had not befell him. For him, there was no reason to suddenly throw himself out the window, nor was there any reason to search for 'how to survive'.

"He failed."

"That is a pity."

His tragedy was, at best, being rejected in a writing contest.

"It's Kim Dokja. Isn't it because someone who is supposed to be read is trying to write something?"

"But he was trying."

"Wouldn't it be hard even if he tried? His name is Kim Dokja, after all."

"That's not the case anymore, is it?"

Cheon Inho spoke as he read the records unfolding before his eyes.

「...And so, Lee Hakhyun wrote ceaselessly. He believed that only the sentences he wrote would not betray him. Writing, and writing again. Writing new sentences in the place where he had erased everything he had worked so hard to write, and despairing time and time again before the completed sentences…」

"That friend is not Kim Dokja."

「…He calmly built up a single world. Even if he couldn't write a perfect piece, he wrote to write something he wouldn't be ashamed of. He poured all my strength into crafting one sentence, then the next. How many times did he write again like that?」

"You know it, don't you?"

Kim Dokja read his brother's writing blankly. Honestly, his brother didn't have a great talent for writing. But he didn't give up. Just as Kim Dokja didn't give up on Ways of

Survival, he, too, never let go of the keyboard. He read books ceaselessly, conceived stories, and typed again.

「"Wow, is it true? You won?"」

Some effort overcomes even fate.

The brother who became a writer through his own efforts.

Watching his brother break free from the shackles of 'Kim Dokja' and begin living his life, Kim Dokja fell into deep contemplation.

"He really keeps writing."

Just like following the serialization of 'Ways of Survival', Kim Dokja followed his brother's story.

"He doesn't give up."

He didn't seem to find the story of the brother amusing, either.

"They say he won another award. Has he really gotten better at writing? Or was he just lucky?"

At times, he seemed jealous.

"Fortunately, my brother has good parents."

"Are you envious?"

Kim Dokja stared blankly at the record describing the brother's parents.

"Rather than that... looking at these people reminds me of something."

"What comes to mind?"

"A very deep and warm spring night..."

Cheon Inho reread the passage Kim Dokja had pointed to. However, no matter how carefully he read it, he could not see a sentence that reminded him of Kim Dokja's description.

"This person named Ji Eunyu here—no matter how I look at it, doesn't it seem like she's interested in my brother? Look, she keeps making jokes."

"Hmm, isn't that mockery, not a joke?"

"Father, you've never been in a relationship, have you?"

Cheon Inho looked at Kim Dokja for a moment and then asked.

"Kim Dokja, why are you so obsessed with his story?"

Kim Dokja did not answer. Like someone who believes the answer lies on pages yet to be read, he simply followed his brother's story in silence.

And so, for a day, two days, three days, a week, Kim Dokja read the story over and over again.

"This friend is Kim Dokja."

Then one day, Kim Dokja said just that.

"He is a Kim Dokja just like me. A Kim Dokja who loves books, admires the protagonist, and is separated from the story he lived in, eventually forgotten by his comrades."

"…"

"But why?"

Kim Dokja paused for a moment and looked down at the record. The record was the story of the moment his brother was selected for the contest for the first time.

「Lee Hakhyun was happy. He was purely happy that someone had read his writing and acknowledged it.」

The fact that a complete stranger was reading his story. The fact that they were counting the time layered within those sentences.

That alone made him feel as though he had received confirmation that it was okay for him to continue writing.」

Cheon Inho also read the record along with him. Just by reading the story, the brightly smiling faces of his brother seemed to come vividly to mind.

"Why don't they look unhappy?"

The moment he heard those words, Cheon Inho felt a heavy weight sink somewhere in his heart. He hesitated for a moment before speaking.

"What do you mean?"

Cheon Inho, having stopped speaking there, suddenly realized a certain fact.

「Kim Dokja once said. That he was not unhappy. That he was fine living in this snowfield forever.」

Cheon Inho looked into Kim Dokja's face. Kim Dokja, who had grown much taller than before as much time had passed as the story had accumulated. Kim Dokja, whose appearance as the boy he knew had vanished, now possessing the same face as the Kim Dokja in the story.

Looking into the emotion in Kim Dokja's eyes, Cheon Inho spoke.

"Kim Dokja, have you perhaps become unhappy?"

Cheon Inho spoke again toward Kim Dokja, who remained silent.

"Just because you saw his story doesn't mean there is any reason for you to be unhappy. He and you are different."

"He is my only brother. Kim Dokja, who, like me, fell away from that story."

Cheon Inho thought for a moment, then asked.

"Did he become unhappy because he didn't share your misfortune?"

"..."

"Some misfortunes are meaningful precisely because they can be enjoyed alone. Isn't that proof that you are special?"

"No, that guy is Kim Dokja, too. I can tell."

His brother, who should have been sharing the only misfortune with him, was smiling, unaware that he was Kim Dokja. As if his past life was unnecessary for his happiness.

"Father once said something like that. That all the stories of this world function for the sake of the protagonist."

"Does he look like the protagonist?"

"..."

"Because he looks happy?"

Kim Dokja slowly lowered his head. As he bowed his head, Kim Dokja's shoulders trembled slightly. Without realizing it, Cheon Inho reached out and placed his hand on his shoulder.

"You are the protagonist. I will make that happen."

Although he was unaccustomed to such comfort, Cheon Inho mustered the courage to say it. However, the moment he finished speaking, Cheon Inho felt a strange sensation. A sensation possessed only by those who had lived as villains. There was a peculiar chill rising from beneath his feet.

And then Cheon Inho realized. Kim Dokja was not crying.

"I had a thought."

Kim Dokja, with his head bowed, was holding back a laugh.

"Could the happiness my brother is enjoying right now be 'fake'?"

Cheon Inho could not understand the words that burst from his mouth.

"I like his story. I think it is cool. My brother, who was born as a different being, not 'Kim Dokja', just as he wished, and came to live his own life. I admire my brother. But __"

Cheon Inho unconsciously removed his hand from Kim Dokja's shoulder.

"He doesn't even know what he was."

Kim Dokja turned to look at Cheon Inho. Watching the hand hover awkwardly in the air, Kim Dokja continued speaking with a smile.

"My brother had no choice. Just as he had no choice when father was designated as the villain. He was suddenly born as a being who was not Kim Dokja, and he is merely

living a life unrelated to his true nature. Therefore—"

A tsutsu sound of sparks flew from somewhere. It was a sound he thought he might never hear again.

"He must have a choice, too."

Cheon Inho realized he was trembling. It was not because he was afraid or shocked by something. It was simply his senses warning him.

「A story is about to begin.」

It was a story that might not have begun if he hadn't held the pen.

「Perhaps it was a story that should never have been written.」

Some stories allow one to predict the ending from the very first sentence.

Nevertheless, the instinct of a recorder was speaking to him.

「Write the story he wants.」

It was giving him a command.

"Father."

When Cheon Inho came to his senses, he found himself kneeling before he knew it. When he lifted his head, the being who had once been his son was looking down at him.

"Gather my fragments."

The moment he felt the weight of those words, Cheon Inho realized where the trembling —this sense of awe—originated.

「A very old dream.」

He was now facing a part of the greatest being in this universe.

"No..."

With his eyes reddened, Cheon Inho shook his head very slowly and desperately.

Shaking off the sense of probability that was binding his entire body, he spoke.

"No..."

Was it a sense of defiance as a villain? Or was it a desperate struggle not to lose the time he had searched for so long?

Cheon Inho looked up at his son like someone begging to withdraw an order.

Kim Dokja. The first child he had found. The boy who had grown up reading his stories, and then reading the stories he had gathered.

Cheon Inho desperately reached out his hand toward the young man who had devoured all those stories and had now become a god.

Kim Dokja grasped his hand with a benevolent smile and said,

"Go, Father. Gather the fragments."

Cheon Inho realized. This was a record he could not change. All he could do was transcribe the dream desired by the Great Being.

As the fragment of the Oldest Dream beckoned, the empty snowfield began to split open.

"So that I may become stronger. So that I may seize control of more. So that I may intervene in the conclusion of this entire universe. So that I can make the story I desire come true."

A portal appeared in the center of the swirling snowfield. The door leading outside, which had never opened despite walking and wandering for so many years, finally opened. The reason was clear.

「The <Star Stream> wants this story.」

The <Star Stream> was calling for the protagonist of the story once again. As if responding to that call, Kim Dokja spoke.

"And let's give my brother a choice. Let him choose for himself. Give him a chance to see if he can still make the same choice even after realizing the truth."

Cheon Inho wanted to ask. What was the meaning of all this? Why did they have to orchestrate such things?

"Only then can the ■ ■■■ ■■■ that this entire universe desires be born."

Perhaps due to the aftershock, Kim Dokja's words were barely audible. Yet, even while unable to hear, Cheon Inho thought.

It was impossible to realize.

Kim Dokja's brother was born in a world without scenarios. He lives in a world outside the sphere where the power of the <Star Stream> does not reach.

Even if it were the 'Oldest Dream', one could not suddenly drag such a being into the gravity of scenarios and thrust it in—Cheon Inho thought.

"Father."

However, his son had already thought of the method.

「A way to insert a being from outside the scenarios into this scenario.」

Kim Dokja's cold hand touched Cheon Inho's cheek.

"For my sake, please become the protagonist of this terrible story once again."

The moment the sweet whisper of the universe spread, Cheon Inho knew what he had to become.

「This is a story about the 'Kim Dokja' we have forgotten.」

The story began to be written amidst the pure white snowflakes.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1016 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (6)

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I read Snowfield’s story meticulously from beginning to end. I read some parts slowly, while others I read quickly, immersed in them without even realizing it. It was a strange feeling.

I am now re-reading the scene where he reads my story as a story myself.

Through this process of reading each other and being read again, we became Kim Dokja.

With a 'pop' sound, the clone of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who had handed me the story fragment, turned into hair. Perhaps it had fulfilled its duty by delivering the fragment of Snowfield to me.

The 'Demon King of Salvation' muttered in my head.

—So this is how it turned out.

I checked once again to see if I had missed any scenes.

There were brief memories even after the scene where Snowfield asked Cheon Inho to collect the fragments of Kim Dokja.

「【I heard the story from the Evil Sophist. So you are that 'Kim Dokja'.】」

The scene where Snowfield Kim Dokja encounters Asmodeus and the 'Recorders of Fear'.

「【O oldest fragment of a dream. Have you come to find the 'unwritten blank space' yet?】」

Up to the scene where he first faces the 'Wenny King'.

Although I could not know exactly what they discussed, there was one certain fact.

「All those stories began to give me a 'choice'.」

The opportunity for me, who had been living a life that was not Kim Dokja, to become Kim Dokja.

Snowfield gave me that opportunity.

By drawing me into his stage and making me live in the body of Cheon Inho.

—But that wouldn't be the whole purpose.

I shared the same thoughts as the Demon King of Salvation. What I read was merely a tiny fraction of the records left by 'Snowfield'.

—If he had truly been curious whether you would choose a life that was not 'Kim Dokja' even after going through all of this, he could have used many other methods.

That's right. The events Snowfield orchestrated were too grand in scale to have occurred merely to watch my choices.

Above all, Snowfield was gathering fragments to become the 'Oldest Dream' himself.

「He has a dream he wishes to dream at the end of this entire universe.」

After reading Snowfield's story, I felt as though I vaguely understood what it was. However, that sensation melted away as quickly as a snowflake settling on my shoulder. Instead, what remained in my hand were the seven blank spaces left by Snowfield.

「Only then can the ■ ■■■ ■■■ that this entire universe desires be born.」

"What is this?"

When I asked, the Demon King of Salvation replied.

—Obvious.

The Demon King of Salvation, a master of filtering analysis, deciphered the blank spaces very simply.

—The one and only Kim Dokja. There is nothing else.

It was an answer anyone would have to agree with. It was certain both circumstantially and in context.

However, that accuracy felt strangely like a trap to me.

"The spacing is different, but there is one more that is seven letters long."

—What?

I stared intently at the filtered blank space, then moved my hand to adjust the number of spaces.

■■ ■■■ ■■.

Just like 'The One and Only Kim Dokja', seven letters.

I know a word that fits this blank space. The moment I was about to say it, the voice of the Demon King of Salvation was heard.

—Youngest.

I suddenly looked up to find other clones of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal gathered in the corner of the gourd.

U-ah.

A troop of monkeys beckoned toward me as if telling me to come over. As I approached them, I saw glittering fragments at the edge of the gourd.

The clones picked up the fragments and handed them to me, as if sharing delicious food.

"This is..."

Could it be another fragment of Snowfield Kim Dokja’s story? The fragments smelled of the sea. Some fragments were hot, as if pulled from a fire.

Rather than properly capturing a story, it was merely a fragment containing the sensation of a certain phenomenon.

I knew the owners of these story fragments.

「Fragments of myth-grade constellations.」

The unrecovered story fragments of myth-grade constellations were there.

"What became of them?"

I recalled the gods who had been imprisoned in the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's prison.

Poseidon, who reminded me of a Marine Corps grandfather; his wife Demeter; Zeus, the electrician; and even Odin, who loved carving.

Even when I surveyed the universe, Mount Five Elements, where the Great Sage Heaven's Equal was imprisoned, was no longer visible. Since the owners of the stories had been cast apart along with the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, had the story fragments I had seen also been unable to escape?

—It was probably sweet.

"You mean they escaped?"

The 'Demon King of Salvation' replied to my question in a calm voice.

—They are the representatives of the massive nebulae. No matter how great the Great Sage Heaven's Equal is, he cannot stop those who sacrifice a part of their true form to escape. They must have suffered a massive blow, but more than half must have safely escaped that world.

Even though they were stories of my enemies, I felt a strange sense of relief at the fact that those stories had not vanished but had flowed away somewhere.

Buzz.

As if sensing my emotions, the fragment of Poseidon clutched in my hand also began to weep softly.

—The scenario area is drawing near.

I could feel it, too. The energy of chaos I had been sensing from afar for some time. The familiar sensation of catastrophe.

「The Great Annihilation Scenario, Ragnarok.」

A destruction far more vast than any scenario I had ever experienced awaited me.

The fragments of the mythical constellations were trembling. As if reluctant to return to where their true forms were.

The starlight of the scenario twinkling across the vast expanse of the universe. Here, the final radiance of the dying constellations shone endlessly beautifully.

—Youngest.

Kim Dokja was calling my name. The Demon King of Salvation, the Great King of Fear, the Prisoner of the Golden Headband, and my brother were calling me.

I nodded. It was time to go.

「Ragnarok.」

To the battlefield where all stars fall.

---

The first to wake up screaming was Poseidon. Amidst the furiously swirling aftershock of probability, Poseidon repeatedly vomited.

[Waaah!]

It was only after sacrificing nearly half of his true body's story that Poseidon was able to escape from the prison of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

Even then, had they not used the power of the 'Round Table' to roll the dice together, they would have all been crushed together by the summoned Mount Five Elements.

「Due to this incident, a number of myth-grade constellations have lost the right to use the 'dice'.」

Thanks to this, the Round Table will not be able to wield its absolute power as before for the time being. It was all caused by a single myth-grade monkey.

Looking around, he saw gods who, just like him, were repeatedly gagging while leaning on the Round Table.

[Aaaargh!]

[Waaah!]

They were all the constellations who had crossed the 'Missing Thicket' with him.

Poseidon frowned as he watched these dignified myth-grade constellations repeatedly vomiting in a wretched state.

[Has everyone returned? I don't see Zeus.]

[Zeus did not descend with us from the beginning.]

The one who spoke those words was Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father', the only one among the powerful gods who maintained his dignity. Although his complexion had turned somewhat pale, he still glared at the Round Table while maintaining his composure.

Upon closer inspection, Odin's hands looked strangely uneasy. His hands, which had been fumbling emptily in the air as if needing something to touch, finally settled only after grasping a small object on the table.

[Strange story fragments have mixed in with us.]

At Odin's words, Poseidon also examined his own story.

Come to think of it, there was something like foreign matter mixed within the story that constituted him.

[Did impurities get mixed in during the escape?]

Poseidon ran his tongue over his cheeks and the roof of his mouth, like someone searching for foreign objects in their mouth. Was it just his imagination? Strangely enough, he suddenly felt the urge to play a recorder.

Thump.

It was then that the Round Table shook slightly. The vibration, initially faint, gradually grew stronger until it began to shake the entire table. Although it was merely the table shaking, the expressions on the faces of the mythical constellations were ominous.

This was because this 'Round Table' was the <Star Stream> itself.

The shaking of the Round Table meant that an event massive enough to threaten the destruction of the entire <Star Stream> had occurred.

And at this point, there was only one such event.

['Ragnarok' has begun.]

Following this, artifacts symbolizing constellations or incarnations appeared on the Round Table.

The first to catch the eye was an artifact bearing a sky-blue flag.

['Throne of Lightning', Zeus.]

Having already descended upon the battlefield, he was moving somewhere.

That was not all. Flags appearing one after another on the Round Table were converging in one spot.

[The final war is about to begin.]

The mythical constellations, their expressions hardening, turned in unison toward one spot.

There stood the head of the noble King, his white flag fluttering.

「The one who will decide the course of this 'battlefield'.」

Odin opened his mouth.

[Finally, the time has come for the 'Oldest Dream' to awaken.]

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In the pitch-black darkness, Killer King looked up at the night sky shining through the gaps in his tent. Shooting stars were falling from the sky.

Killer King thought about the dying constellations. Stars that coveted human stories, unable to bear their inflated desires, and eventually fell from the sky.

Perhaps it is only natural for humans to gaze upon the tragedy in the heavens and find it beautiful.

"Kim Dokja."

Killer King called out the name of one of those stars. But the owner of the name gave no answer. This was because he had fallen from the sky long ago and was on the ground.

「Kim Dokja lay asleep on the barracks bed.」

Killer King rose from his seat and checked Kim Dokja's breathing.

"I don't know what kind of dream you are having, but you must return now."

His breathing was normal, but Kim Dokja still showed no signs of waking up. Killer King looked down at him and muttered.

"Or perhaps this world right now is the dream you are having."

Looking at the face of the deeply sleeping Kim Dokja, Killer King recalled the moment he first met him.

「"I am Kim Dokja."」

A man with the same appearance as Kim Dokja. An incarnation who uses the same skills as Kim Dokja and tackles the scenarios in the same extraordinary way.

A perfect Kim Dokja, undeniably 'Kim Dokja' to anyone.

「"From now on, I will lead the scenarios."」

Nevertheless, every time he called him 'Kim Dokja', Killer King felt an inexplicable sense of guilt. This was because, inside him, 'Kim Dokja' took on the form of someone else.

「In his mind, Kim Dokja had the appearance of Cheon Inho.」

A person who was a bit clumsy compared to the Kim Dokja he knew, easily flustered, and sometimes committed foolish acts.

Nevertheless, the person for whom the name 'Kim Dokja' suited him better than anyone else.

"Kim Dokja."

Without fully knowing who he was calling, Killer King called out that name once again. Then, a memory flashed through his mind like a hallucination.

「"If it makes you uncomfortable, you don't have to call me Kim Dokja."」

The Kim Dokja standing before him had once said that to Killer King, who found it difficult to call him Kim Dokja.

「"Are you still okay with that?"」

When Killer King hesitated and asked back, Kim Dokja replied.

「"I am fine."」

「"You don't look fine."」

「"If I say I am not fine."」

After a moment of silence, Kim Dokja added with a peculiar expression.

「"Is there anything you can do for me?"」

Killer King could not fathom what state of mind Kim Dokja was in as he said those words.

The Kim Dokja he knew always had other colleagues by his side. Han Sooyoung, Yoo Sangah, Jung Heewon, Lee Hyunsung, Lee Jihye, Kim Namwoon, Shin Yoosung, Lee Gilyoung, and <Kim Dokja Company> were there. And Yoo Joonghyuk was there.

But who remains by Kim Dokja's side now?

「"I."」

"Oppa."

Killer King snapped out of his thoughts at his younger sibling's call. Cha Yerin was resting her hand on his shoulder.

After checking on the sleeping Kim Dokja, Cha Yerin let out a light sigh and immediately stated her purpose.

"There's a problem."

He didn't need to ask what the problem his sibling was talking about to be. Killer King had sensed it, too. He knew that an ominous energy had been gathering outside the barracks for some time.

Some energy was familiar, others unfamiliar. However, the momentum emanating from them was all similar.

"They've come."

"Yes."

Killer King gazed briefly at Kim Dokja, who remained asleep. Then, his question came to mind once again.

「"If I say I am not okay, is there anything you can do for me?"」

Perhaps it was time to answer that question now.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1017 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (7)

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The X-Class Ferrari, speeding down the unpaved road, rattled slightly. Ji Eunyu, sitting in the passenger seat, was looking out the window. Outside, black rain was falling steadily.

"It's raining heavily."

Fragments of stories were clinging to the black rain. As she placed her hand against the windowpane, the story fragments, screaming as if they had been waiting for this moment, flowed right down.

As Ji Eunyu took a deep breath and removed her hand from the window, Anna Croft, who was holding the steering wheel, asked.

"Are you alright?"

Ji Eunyu nodded and replied.

"I'm alright."

How could she be alright? The world was ending. Lava erupted from the cracked ground and swallowed the living, and stars in the sky fell from the sky at thunder that struck from somewhere.

「This black rain was the scream of the stars that had been alive just moments before.」

It was a situation where no one could say they were okay. Yet, the reason she could say she was fine was perhaps due to the power of the skill she possessed.

[Exclusive Skill, 'Abnormal Adaptability Lv.???', is activated!]

An exclusive skill that Kim Namwoon, one of the characters, also possessed.

Thanks to this skill, Ji Eunyu passed the first scenario and was able to calmly utilize the knowledge of this world she knew.

「"I guess I can't point out the lack of probability to author-nim anymore."」

On the first day that the implausible event of a novel becoming reality occurred, she thought of the person who wrote this story.

Whether it was a misfortune or a blessing, she had once asked her assigned author the following question.

「"If you were transmigrated in a novel, what would you do first?"」

Perhaps because it was a question that the extremely realistic Ji Eunyu would never ask, her author pondered for a long time before answering as follows.

「"You have to choose a sponsor, right?"」

「"Kim Dokja didn't choose."」

「"Are you Kim Dokja?"」

「"Well, then... who are you going to choose?"」

Perhaps it was because she pointed out the lack of probability every single day. As expected, her editor pondered the answer for quite a while before saying the following:

「"I will choose a constellation that does not appear in the original work."」

「"What? That carries a high risk, doesn't it?"」

「"It's just as dangerous no matter who you choose. And who knows? An option that no one else chose could win the lottery."」

Normally, she would have shouted, "Not that ridiculous nonsense again!" but this time, she faithfully followed his advice. It was a matter of survival.

[The constellation, 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight', looks upon you with concern.]

And so, her patron star became 'Moonlight Empress Yoo Sangah', a member of <Kim Dokja Company>. Had the editor been by his side, he likely would have shouted this with his characteristic cheesy gestures:

「"See! Congratulations on winning the lottery."」

Even after that, she recalled his advice every time she made a choice. Whether clearing a scenario, obtaining a reward, or going through a growth event.

「"No matter how steadily you grow, unless you are the protagonist, there is a growth limit. How are you going to solve that?"」

「"I have to leech off the protagonist."」

「"What if that isn't possible?"」

「"Then... There must be only one way."」

Ji Eunyu often wondered. If they met again, would he give the same answer? Even in this world where the novel had truly become reality, would he give the same advice as he did back then?

「"The Covenant of the Other World."」

In the story, Kim Dokja warns about the 'Covenant of the Other World' several times. However, both Kim Dokja and Han Sooyoung made that covenant. And they survived.

Although both of them pay a terrible price because of it, Ji Eunyu nevertheless considered it an adventure worth attempting.

「【You who do not yet know what your ■■ is, fine. I will exchange the knowledge you possess for the power of 'Records'.】」

She made the 'Covenant of the Other World' with the Wenny clan.

【Truly strange. You already possess the 'Talent of Recording'. A recorder specialized in 'Editing'…】

She obtained the power of a 'Recorder of Fear'. Having become able to revise [Fate], she also acquired the qualification to trade with the Nebulae. There were crises several times along the way, but whenever a crisis arose, she endured by thinking of the person who wrote this story. What would he have done? What development would he have written next? What choice would he have made?

「For Ji Eunyu, living in this world was also about understanding a person.」

Some memories grow while being ruminated, and some bonds deepen when apart.

While living in the world he recorded and struggling to survive, she dreamt a lot about her assigned writer.

「"If there is just one thing I regret..."」

Immediately after finishing the main story, her writer said that.

「"As expected, the ending..."」

「"If you were to write it again, would you want a different ending?"」

「"If that were possible..."」

After pondering for a long time again, her writer finally gave a wry smile and said.

「"No. This ending is the best, after all."」

What other ending had her author dreamed of? Ji Eunyu had come this far thinking about it.

"Cloud Mountain."

Was she lost in thought too deeply? Ji Eunyu realized a little late that Anna Croft was calling her.

"Yes."

When she answered, Anna said.

"I have heard a lot about you."

"From whom?"

"The stars."

Anna Croft's eyes emitted a brilliant red light.

"I heard that only those who have seen the end of a world, or at least those who have achieved equivalent feats, qualify as 'Recorders of Fear'. But I hear you have already earned the title of 'Recorder'."

"…"

"I heard that you were the one who gathered the incarnations for this 'Ragnarok'."

Instead of answering, Ji Eunyu surveyed the vehicles behind her in the side mirror. Hundreds of vehicles were following them from behind. They were forces of incarnations from various nations.

The Korean forces that followed Cheon Inho. And even the overseas incarnations who had received help from him at least once.

"I never thought a single incarnation could accomplish this. You are truly amazing."

"No, not at all. You're the amazing one."

Ji Eunyu knew how Anna Croft had made it this far.

"You're the only one who survived after fighting so many preliminary battles for 'Ragnarok'."

"If he hadn't helped me, I would already be dead."

Ji Eunyu also knew who 'he' Anna Croft was referring to.

After a moment of hesitation, Anna Croft spoke again.

"Kim Dokja has spoken about you."

"What did he say?"

"He told me to find you first, no matter what, once the scenario begins."

Ji Eunyu nodded, saying 'Ah', then urgently asked back.

"Is that all?"

Perhaps noticing the strangely disappointed look on Ji Eunyu's face, Anna Croft quickly added.

"He also said you are the person he trusts the most."

"...You haven't heard from him yet?"

"Yes."

The two were silent for a moment. Although no words were exchanged, they knew that at that moment, they shared the same thought.

"It will be alright. Because he is a strong person."

"You trust him."

"If I didn't trust him, I wouldn't have been able to come this far. It is the same for you."

Anna Croft nodded. She took two torn tickets from her bosom. They were scalped tickets Kim Dokja had given her. Because of these tickets, she was able to come as part of the 'Army of Calamity' and meet Ji Eunyu, who had chosen the same faction.

"How is [Future Sight]? Do you see anything?"

"I see nothing."

The amount of black rain falling through the car window had increased compared to before. It must mean that many stars are falling from the sky.

Anna Croft asked again.

"Are you really going to push ahead like this? Wouldn't it be better to wait for Kim Dokja or Yoo Joonghyuk to arrive?"

Even if it was unavoidable that Kim Dokja was out of contact, it was worth waiting for Yoo Joonghyuk, who had stepped away for a moment. However, Ji Eunyu shook her head.

"It is right for us to move immediately, even if it is just us. The mythical constellations of the Round Table have vanished. An opportunity like this probably won't come again."

For reasons unknown, the 'Round Table' of the constellations had lost its power. This caused a massive power vacuum in 'Ragnarok', bringing the battlefield into a temporary

lull.

Now was the only time to change the fate of this world.

"You have arrived."

With a light pause, Ferrargini came to a halt. Ji Eunyu and Anna Croft instructed the party behind them to wait briefly before walking forward. Anna Croft muttered softly,

"Up close, their power is immense."

Even within the same 'Army of Calamity,' there are differences in strength between factions.

The place they had just arrived at was one of the largest groups within the Calamity faction of this 'Ragnarok'. The Calamity side refers to this faction as follows:

「Snow White.」

The presence of terrifying Outer Gods was felt from within the Nest of Calamity, which seemed to be settled in a pure white ash.

However, they were all deeply asleep. As if waiting for their master, or as if they knew it was not yet time to wake up.

Ji Eunyu and Anna Croft waited for a while at the back door of the camp. Anna Croft asked.

"Will he really help?"

"He will help."

"But I heard he has been with this faction for a long time."

"Since he has been with us for so long, he has no choice but to help. Because he was the one who wanted to become 'Kim Dokja' more than any of us."

Not long after, the back door of the camp opened. The man who appeared was someone Ji Eunyu also knew well.

"Ye Hyunwoo-ssi."

The man was Ye Hyunwoo. Now a young man after eight years, Ye Hyunwoo greeted the two with a somewhat tired expression.

"So you finally came."

Ji Eunyu nodded.

"Because the promised time has come."

Ji Eunyu, having pulled the cape she had prepared in advance over her head, asked.

"Has Snow White woken up?"

The Snow White. A being known among the Recorders of Fear as 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

Ye Hyunwoo bit his lip softly at that nickname and replied.

"He is still asleep. But he will wake up soon."

"Please guide us."

"Are you two going alone?"

"If he hasn't woken up yet, there is no point in causing a commotion."

Ye Hyunwoo let out a light sigh and began walking ahead. As if orders had been given in advance, he headed toward the core of the camp.

Meanwhile, no one stopped them.

Ye Hyunwoo glanced at Ji Eunyu's equipment and asked.

"Do you have a plan in mind? Even if he is asleep, using your power incorrectly on him could backfire."

"If he really is asleep, there is a way."

Ji Eunyu took an apple out of her bosom. Ye Hyunwoo's eyes wavered greatly upon seeing the apple. It was because he recognized what kind of object it was.

「The Witch's Apple.」

"If he really is 'Snow White', it won't be easy to escape the 'Stage-ization' effect of this apple."

Ye Hyunwoo stared at the apple for a moment then asked.

"Do you really have to do this?"

"Yes."

"He is also a part of the 'Kim Dokja' we know. Isn't there a way to try persuading him one last time?"

Instead of answering, Ji Eunyu stared at Ye Hyunwoo for a moment. Then, she replied in a calm and clear tone.

"You should know better than I do what kind of 'Kim Dokja' he is."

"…"

"He is the one who tore apart other Kim Dokjas with his own hands. Because of him, all this tragedy unfolded. If he had been someone who could be persuaded, the other Kim Dokjas wouldn't have ended up like that."

Ye Hyunwoo listened to her story silently. It was a story both of them knew by now. How this world was created, and why this tragedy began.

"You know what will become of this world if we let such a Kim Dokja become 'the one and only Kim Dokja'."

Ye Hyunwoo did not deny Ji Eunyu's words. Instead, he gazed at the tent visible in the distance. A tent where a pale flag waved. It was the place where their goal lay dormant.

Ye Hyunwoo, who had been walking ahead, stopped abruptly and spoke.

"I clearly agreed with your will, so I will not stop you. However."

He glanced at Ji Eunyu, who stood beside him, and added.

"Keep this in mind. Not every reader shares your thoughts."

The next moment, the curtain opened, and a man and a woman appeared as if they had been waiting. Ji Eunyu gazed at the man standing further forward and spoke.

"Second Apostle."

Then the Second Apostle—Killer King—nodded and replied.

"Lord of the Apostles."

It was the moment when the two people who had read this story more than anyone else in this world faced each other.

The two looked at each other for a moment, as if gauging the world they had read and lived in—or the end of the story they had read.

It was Killer King who spoke first.

"Have you come to kill Kim Dokja?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1018 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (8)

"Please step aside."

Killer King did not back down despite Ji Eunyu's cold voice. Instead, he stared at Ye Hyunwoo, who was standing behind Ji Eunyu observing the situation.

"Hyunwoo, so you chose that path in the end."

Ye Hyunwoo turned his head away when their eyes met, as if he could not bear to meet his gaze. Averting his eyes from Ye Hyunwoo, Killer King looked back at Ji Eunyu and spoke.

"You cannot meet Kim Dokja."

"Kim Dokja."

With Ji Eunyu's words, stories rippled from her entire body. Ye Hyunwoo and Anna Croft opened their eyes wide. It was because they sensed the caliber of the stories emanating from her.

「At least narrative-grade, and a caliber comparable to the Twelve Divine Seats of <Olympus>.」

Killer King was the only one who remained unfazed. Facing Killer King, Ji Eunyu asked.

"Do you really believe that man is 'Kim Dokja'?"

Black rain was drizzling across the night sky of Ragnarok. The stories of the fallen stars. Staring at the remnants of those stories scattered everywhere, Killer King spoke.

"Yes. That guy is Kim Dokja."

"Are you serious?"

Ji Eunyu glared at Killer King, unable to hide her disappointment.

"You know very well who the real Kim Dokja is."

"He left us a long time ago."

"What if he has returned?"

Killer King's eyes wavered.

"How can I believe that?"

"Because I saw him with my own eyes. At the 'Archives' in Bicheonhori."

The Archives in Bicheonhori. Killer King knew about that place, too.

"You must have heard the rumors, too. That there is an incarnation who devastated the 'New Murim District' and ascended to 'Ragnarok'."

Killer King was silent for a moment. He gazed at the distant sky, appearing to be deep in thought, or perhaps searching for a star lost long ago.

"Even if he has returned, it is too late now."

"Is it because of Yerin-ssi? I heard that he saved her."

While breaking through the mid-scenarios, Cha Yerin suffered injuries severe enough to damage her spiritual body.

At the time, Killer King barely managed to obtain the 'Holy Oil Fruit' with the help of Snowfield Kim Dokja, and was able to save his younger sibling.

"That has nothing to do with it."

"Then why are you stopping me?"

Killer King continued to stare at the sky. A single star twinkled in the distance. Killer King slowly opened his mouth.

"There was a story. And there was a boy who read that story."

"…"

"Born without knowing his parents or his origins, he lived relying solely on that story."

Ji Eunyu listened to the story in silence.

"The boy tried to resemble the protagonist of the story. He memorized the lines the protagonist muttered. He imitated the expressions the protagonist frequently made. He even mimicked his mannerisms."

"…"

"'I am Yoo Joonghyuk', 'I am Yoo Joonghyuk'…"

"That story…"

"His misfortune felt exactly like mine."

Killer King stared at Ji Eunyu with piercing eyes, as if piercing right through her.

"It seemed as though he were saying so. That this misfortune was special. That it was a privilege granted only to the protagonist."

At first glance, it sounded very similar to 'Kim Dokja's' story. But it was not Kim Dokja's story.

It was Killer King's story.

"Is that pity? Do you think he is similar to you?"

To Ji Eunyu's question, the boy who had grown up reading that story and imitating the protagonist answered.

"No one becomes an orphan by their own choice. I am merely speaking as a reader."

"What are you trying to say?"

"I know that 'Kim Dokja' isn't the 'protagonist' of the story we read. However—"

Killer King paused briefly before continuing.

"It suddenly occurred to me. Does the protagonist of the story we read also consider the man inside that tent a 'fake'?"

"…"

"Does Kim Dokja really think that 'Kim Dokja' is someone who must disappear?"

As Ji Eunyu hesitated to answer, Killer King asked again.

"What is your Kim Dokja saying?"

Ji Eunyu realized that this fight was unavoidable.

This is a battle to prove each other's reading.

A duel to prove each other's 'Kim Dokja' through the stories they have lived through.

"Because as the editor of this story, I am merely trying to erase him."

Killer King nodded.

"You are prepared, aren't you? This is a 'story'."

"Outer Gods won't interfere."

The clash between the two sparked in the air. However, the Outer Gods in the area did not react.

"Because they have no reason to step forward."

Neither the sleeping Outer Gods nor those who had just woken up intervened in the clash occurring at the center of the Disaster Faction. The reason was clear.

「Now, two 'Fragments of Kim Dokja' will collide here.」

Regardless of which side won, the Outer Gods who revered the 'Oldest Dream' had no reason to intervene. If one of them were destroyed, the fragments would be theirs.

Killer King, having grasped the Outer Gods' intentions, gave a wry smile.

"At this rate, it was practically an empty house from the start."

The Outer Gods watched, and the constellations left their posts.

The only thing existing within this Disaster Faction right now was the fighting spirit of the two.

"Yerin-ah."

As Killer King opened his mouth, Cha Yerin stepped forward. Cha Yerin, meeting Ji Eunyu's gaze, bowed her head low and spoke.

"I'm sorry."

Ji Eunyu shook her head.

If Killer King had chosen to side with the other party, naturally his younger sibling would also take the same side. It was only natural.

"It's a shame. I wanted to talk more with you, Yerin-ssi."

Biting her lip, Cha Yerin quietly raised her fists. A swirling snowstorm wrapped around her two fists.

Killer King spoke.

"Step back, even now."

A faint link formed between the two siblings, and a controller appeared before Killer King's eyes.

[Incarnation, 'Lee Seyeon' activates skill 'Battle Action Mode'!]

[Battle Action Mode, the Killer King siblings' specialty.]

Seeing no sign of Ji Eunyu backing down, Killer King immediately activated the command.

"Dark Spinning Breaker."

[Advanced Command activated successfully!]

Command input without a shred of hesitation. Killer King could now activate this technique, which was previously considered a finishing move, with great ease.

[The exclusive trait of incarnation,' Lee Seyeon', is activated!]

[The attack power of the corresponding command increases!]

The ground in the vicinity shook as Cha Yerin's claws, enveloped in [White Blue Energy], struck.

Kugugugu!

It was a truly formidable level of destructive power. It was a strike that would be difficult to block even for the constellations, let alone Ji Eunyu.

However, Ji Eunyu, who emerged from the dust, was completely unharmed. Cha Yerin's claws stopped right in front of her nose as she tightly wrapped the surrounding air with [Arachne's Threads].

Looking at the dazzling [White Blue Energy] contained within her claws, Ji Eunyu spoke.

"I'm sorry, but I didn't come here alone either."

Before Cha Yerin could even answer, a sharp dagger flew toward her side. As she hurriedly swung her claws to deflect the dagger, a glowing red eye met hers.

"Prophet."

Cha Yerin's expression hardened, and her movements quickened. As a series of [Fighting Action] combos—which could be used without commands—unleashed one after another, Anna Croft groaned and stepped back.

Despite facing none other than 'Anna Croft', Cha Yerin did not back down in the slightest. No, rather, it felt as though she was overwhelming her with pure physical strength.

"I did hear that you ate the Holy Oil Fruit, but honestly, this is surprising."

Cha Yerin's story was creating a fervent flow through her Story Vein.

Stories shining brightly, like type printed on clean paper.

The power of that story was contained within the fists and kicks flying in without a moment's respite.

Before long, Anna Croft's entire body was covered in wounds, large and small. No matter how exceptional an incarnation Anna Croft was, her forte was information warfare based on [Future Sight]. She was incompatible with Cha Yerin, a born martial artist. Nevertheless, Anna Croft did not appear flustered.

"You are more than I heard from Kim Dokja."

A shaken Cha Yerin was about to say something but hurriedly bent over. A stealthy killing intent. A flash of lightning swept through the air and grazed her head.

Admiring her reflexes, the opponent muttered,

"I didn't expect you to dodge it."

Cha Yerin recognized the owner of the lightning that had cut off her hair.

"Asuka Ren."

Asuka Ren, Japan's greatest incarnation, was there. Standing side by side with Anna Croft, she asked,

"You said you couldn't dodge it if I mentioned that name? Are you sure you can see the future?"

"The future associated with him often goes awry."

"Let's strike together."

Anna Croft activated [Foresight], and Asuka Ren protected her. As the two top-tier incarnations began their pincer attack, even Cha Yerin began to find herself gradually losing the upper hand.

Under the protection of [Foresight], which reads all battle information, Asuka Ren's sword strikes squeezed into her weak point faster than she anticipated.

A burst of story erupted with a "Pishuu!"

Cha Yerin bit her lip tightly. It was a situation where she truly had to fight with the resolve to kill her opponent. However, her command input was delayed.

Kugugugu!

A dust storm rose in front of the tent where Killer King was standing.

Ji Eunyu, having dodged Killer King's fist that flew through the air, spoke.

"[Hundred Steps Divine Fist]. You have mastered Yoo Joonghyuk's technique."

"I learned it after saving a dying Shaolin monk. Is yours [Cloud Steps]?"

Instead of answering, Ji Eunyu drew her sword from her bosom. Killer King also drew his crossbow.

"[Gangmashi]."

Arrows raining down from close range flew straight toward Ji Eunyu.

The moment Ji Eunyu dodged the arrows with [Ways of the Wind], Killer King spoke as if he had been waiting for this moment.

"[Blood Explosion]."

The flying Gangmashi exploded in unison. At the same time, his Stigmata residing in the arrowheads activated.

「Commander of the Red Cosmos, Yophiel's [Unit 503].」

Small soldiers gripping sharp spears poured out from the red mist. Yophiel's Holy Soul, [Unit 503], which tears everything apart, had unleashed its power. At this close range, it was a blow that would inflict fatal wounds even on constellations of the narrative-grade.

Nevertheless, Ji Eunyu shuffled out, pushing through the red mist. Killer King, having confirmed the story protecting her body, muttered.

"[Protective Energy], [Repulsion Energy], and even [Immortal Body] on top of that… Just how many defensive techniques has you learned?"

The ability to withstand a narrative-grade Archangel's [Stigmata] solely through skill stacking.

But the real potential of Apostle Order Leader Ji Eunyu was not only this.

"I've never learned it."

"What?"

"I merely read it. Just—"

Ji Eunyu's sword moved.

"I just read it with all my might."

Watching the swordplay ripple as if alive, Killer King realized what kind of martial art it was.

[Emperor Sword Form.]

It was the martial art of the annihilated Namgung clan. However, in a sense, it was not the [Emperor Sword Form] he knew.

"How—"

Firing dozens of demon-strengthening arrows at the charging Ji Eunyu, Killer King was reading someone's shadow within her.

"…Yoo Joonghyuk."

Her sword was different from Yoo Joonghyuk's. However, the desperation embedded in its explosive power reminded him of the man he had always admired.

How could such a thing be possible?

"Surely not."

No incarnation he knew could wield a sword like that. No matter how great her talent or how much grueling effort she had put in, it was an impossible task.

And Killer King, who remembered this story better than anyone, knew of a single characteristic that could make the impossible possible.

"[A Life of Full Power]."

A characteristic that allows one to unleash all their talents instead of living a predetermined lifespan.

Ji Eunyu approached, deflecting arrows, her steps deep. Watching her footsteps, Killer King realized something.

He, too, believed he had lived the past eight years doing his best. He thought he had worked hard and struggled.

「The weight of the history lived is different.」

Even if one spends the same amount of time or reads the same stories, the sentences that accumulate within each person's inner self are different.

As if substituting all answers with her sword strikes, Ji Eunyu continued to swing her sword. Despite the barrage of arrows flying in real-time and the ensuing [Blood Explosion], the distance between the two was gradually narrowing.

When the distance finally closed to within a stone's throw, Ji Eunyu deflected the last arrow and spoke.

"There are incarnations waiting outside. They are all incarnations you know, too."

Killer King knew, too. He had felt a gaze peering in from outside the camp for quite some time.

The incarnations were watching their fight.

Among them were familiar figures. Bang Cheolsoo of the Inho faction. And even the beggars of the Beggars' Sect who had come from Seoul Station.

The incarnations who had endured the scenarios together were watching this battle.

"Your Kim Dokja has been sufficiently proven."

Watching Ji Eunyu aim her sword at him, Killer King realized. From the very beginning, she had no intention of continuing this fight to the end.

"No one will blame you."

She was trying to give him a chance.

"You know it, too. You know how this story will end if you leave Snow White alone."

"I don't know."

"No, you do know. Because you saw how Kyung Sein-ssi and Lee Dansu-ssi were abandoned."

Memories flowing like hallucinations.

Killer King shook his head once again.

"They weren't abandoned. They weeded out of their own accord."

"Do you really think so? Is the Kim Dokja you've been reading really saying that?"

The sharply honed sentence pierced Killer King's soul like the tip of a blade.

"I—"

Ji Eunyu took a breath and delivered the final blow.

"You have read this story too many times."

Killer King's crossbow shattered. Along with the crossbow that fell to the floor, Ji Eunyu spoke as if to bring the fight to an end.

"He is not Kim Dokja."

What defines Kim Dokja as Kim Dokja?

Killer King spoke with trembling lips.

"I think he is Kim Dokja."

"Who are you?"

Killer King could not answer.

Who is he? What exactly is he within this story?

Or what did he want to become?

「He was merely a reader.」

All the understanding he had built was based solely on that flimsy text.

「Despite so many 'rereads', he ultimately could not become anything to Kim Dokja.」

This relationship was nothing more than a one-sided bond forged by persistent and repeated reading.

Killer King answered, even while fully aware of this fact.

"I am his comrade."

"Does he think so too?"

"That doesn't matter..."

"He is a monster who intends to see the end of this world, even if it means destroying all his comrades. Do you really think someone like that could have comrades?"

Killer King's pupils trembled violently.

Ji Eunyu approached slowly and placed her hand on his shoulder.

"Even if it were Yoo Joonghyuk, he wouldn't stand by such a monster. You did your best. You can stop now."

Ji Eunyu walked past Killer King. Killer King could not stop her.

「It has already been decided who understands this story better.」

Now, it was just over ten steps to the tent. Ji Eunyu slowly took an apple out of her bosom. It was time to execute the plan. Snow White. It was time to send the prince inside that tent into an eternal dream.

However, her steps stopped when she was three steps away from the tent.

"Second Apostle."

As she slowly turned her back, there stood Killer King, looking blank. An ominous energy surged from Killer King's entire body as he closed his eyes.

"You..."

Ji Eunyu, her expression hardening, gripped her sword tighter. The 'Recorder's' premonition was warning her.

A strange-shaped halo rose above Killer King's head, and a dazzling archangel's aura surged from his entire body. Along with a chilling sensation, a trembling energy seized the area.

Tsutsutsutsutsu!

An event powerful enough to cause a massive aftershock on the battlefield of 'Ragnarok'. Killer King was not merely borrowing the power of 'Yophiel'. For instance, this was—a probability akin to a moving nebula.

"I have not yet given my all."

Ji Eunyu gazed at Killer King with trembling eyes.

「This is a reader who has read this world more than anyone else, and stakes everything.」

One by one, archangels began to appear behind him.

[The constellation, 'Friend of Justice and Harmony', descends into the scenario!]

Archangel Raguel.

[The constellation, 'One Who Faces God', descends into the scenario!]

Great Warrior Kamael.

[The constellation, 'Lily of Aquarius', descends into the scenario!]

Archangel Gabriel.

[The constellation, 'Commander of the Red Cosmos', descends into the scenario!]

And even Archangel Yophiel.

It was the moment the Archangels of <Eden>, feared by the Demon Kings, manifested their true forms in the scenario.

At the center of that breathtaking scene, the shadow of the Archangel with the largest wings fell.

[The constellation, 'Scribe of Heaven', descends into the scenario!]

The Scribe of Heaven—Archangel Metatron. As the pure white hand of the Archangel touched Killer King's shoulder, his shoulder blade tore open and wings sprouted.

"You're right. Right now, he has no one.

Not even that Yoo Joonghyuk."

Amidst the scattering of pitch-black feathers, Killer King slowly opened his eyes and spoke.

"Therefore, now, someone must become his Yoo Joonghyuk."

[The story, 'Gray Guardian', begins its storytelling.]

[NOTE 1]

**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Still 30 chapters +3 left.

# 1019 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (9)

The Guardian of Gray.

Ji Eunyu, who had become a 'Recorder of Fear', understood the entire situation the moment she saw that story name.

"Metatron! This is not a matter for you <Eden> to interfere in!"

Killer King's soul flickered as if about to fade away. Meanwhile, the records of [Fate] governing his incarnation were becoming more vivid.

「Killer King made a contract with <Eden>, staking all his stories.」

A direct contract with a giant nebula.

It was obvious what kind of fate a mere incarnation would face if they committed such an act.

[Recorder of the Otherworld.]

Metatron spoke, looking down at Ji Eunyu with a haughty gaze.

[We have merely chosen our 'Acting President'.]

Acting President. Ji Eunyu knew exactly what weight was contained in that declaration.

"Are you out of your mind? How could those so-called Archangels—"

[What use are good and evil in the face of the destruction of the worldline?]

Metatron had made his choice. He believed that now was the moment for the Nebula <Eden> to be recorded in the grand narrative of destruction. That it was time to borrow the pen known as Killer King and record their stories.

[Exclusive trait activated!]

Ji Eunyu manifested the power of a 'Recorder' She had to change [Fate] somehow. She could not let Killer King die here. No matter how much he stood on the side of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', he was not someone who should have died in a place like this.

However, even with her power, there was no way to change [Fate].

「Once this fight ends, Killer King will surely die.」

Ji Eunyu shook her head time and time again, trying to find a different development. She was an editor. The only being who could interfere with the direction of a story when a writer wanted to write it. The person who could advise on a better development, a better plot. However, the author of this story was not here, and all she could do was helplessly read the sentences being mercilessly written down.

"Ji Eunyu."

Killer King called her name for the first time. At the same time, Ji Eunyu also recalled Killer King's name.

"Cha Seongwoo-ssi."

"Perhaps this is my last page."

Cha Seongwoo had a calm gaze, like someone who had already accepted his fate.

But meeting those eyes, Ji Eunyu felt her heart tighten.

It was only at that moment that Ji Eunyu realized what kind of being she had perceived Killer King to be.

「Both of them have read this story more diligently than anyone else.」

One as a reader, and the other as an editor.

Although they had reached this point playing different roles within this story, their faith in it was the same for both of them.

"I wanted to read this story forever."

Even after enduring such horrific events, neither of them could hate the story.

Even as they nearly died time and time again and again, and lost loved ones, they lived this story. They executed the next scenario, and the one after that.

「It was because they were curious about the end of this story they had lived through.」

It is the destiny of those who have fallen in love with a story.

Standing before the conclusion of that story, the reader who had read this world alongside her was speaking.

"'Reading together' ends here."

Now, only one of the two can read the next page.

"Come at me with all your might."

The moment the grandeur of the Great Election surged from Cha Seongwoo's entire body, Ji Eunyu turned around and summoned the incarnations.

"Bang Cheolsoo! Mujeong and her daughter!"

"I obey your command!"

As if he had been waiting, Bang Cheolsoo of Geumho Station appeared at the center of the Disaster camp with his squad members.

"Charge!"

He, who was once a gangster boss, was now fighting against the constellations with the scenarios coming to an end.

[The constellation, 'Lord of the Ruffians', cackles as it cheers on its incarnation.]

The excited 'Lord of the Ruffians', the sponsor behind Bang Cheolsoo, also sent an indirect message. It seemed to enjoy the thought of its incarnation getting beaten up once again.

However, this fight was not going to end with just getting beaten up a bit.

['Evil'.]

Yophiel, having read Bang Cheolsoo's sins with the [Eyes of Sin], reached out his hand. Immediately, an explosive red mist poured out from the Archangel's palm.

[Unit 503 ravaging the battlefield.]

The red mist swept through the camp like a swarm of bees, engulfing Bang Cheolsoo and his party.

"Aaaaaaaah!"

The horrific screams of the humans filled the battlefield. The Holy Soul of a High-Ranking Archangel. It was a power that a mere human incarnation could not withstand.

However, Yophiel's expression remained hardened. Through the red mist, the shimmering shadows of the incarnations spoke.

"...Did you think I was going to say that?"

A moment later, Bang Cheolsoo and the Inho squad members emerged from the fog. Armed from head to toe in pitch-black full plate armor, they appeared to have survived the [503 Unit] raid without sustaining any major injuries.

That couldn't be right.

They blocked the stigmata with just a single piece of full plate armor?

"Is this all? You damned constellations."

Yophiel's eyebrows furrowed. Upon closer inspection, the full plate armor of the incarnations was imbued with stories.

[The blessing of the constellation, 'Master of Steel', is with you.]

Story metal forged from the metal of the planet 'Oz'.

All members of the Inho squad were armed with the hardest metal in this world.

"Charge—!"

Watching Bang Cheolsoo, Kamael, who had been observing from the sidelines, gestured.

[Kill them all.]

With the Archangel's gesture, the Nine Wind Angels, the main force of <Eden>, poured out of the portal.

A massive wave of angels reminiscent of the Holy War.

As if to counter that wave, the girl perched on Bang Cheolsoo's shoulder shouted.

"Mom!"

At the girl's signal, her mother, who was running beside Bang Cheolsoo, also shouted.

"Dayoung!"

"Yes!"

The mother and daughter leaped simultaneously. As if they had been waiting, the Nine Order Angels thrust their spears toward the mother and daughter.

At the same time, an ominous aura emanated from the entire bodies of Mujeong and her daughter.

[They are those who have contracted with the Outer Gods!]

Recognizing their power, the Nine Order Angels shouted.

「In the battlefield of 'Ragnarok', some incarnations who have chosen the 'Army of Calamity' can form one-on-one contracts with Outer Gods.」

The otherworldly deity contracted by Mujeong and her daughter is 'Shadow of the Seabed'. By the standards of the Fear Realm, it was a 'Disaster-level fear', but in combat against humans, it was an Outer God possessing combat power comparable to a 'Natural Cataclysm-level fear'.

「The hunters of the seabed will hold their breath in the shadows of the deep sea.」

The figures of the mother and daughter slipped right into the shadows of the Ninth Order of Angels.

The moment the startled Ninth Order of Angels burst into astonishment.

[Aaaargh!]

The daggers of the heartless mother and daughter, sprang from the Archangel's shadow, severed the angels' ankles. The severed ankles were sucked straight into the shadows on the ground. Along with a crunching sound, the sound of something inside the shadows devouring the angels' ankles could be heard.

[Aaaargh! There is something in here!]

Frowning, Kamael shouted as if to encourage the lower-ranking angels.

[Do not panic. Everyone, turn your backs to one another and gather. Gathering shadows allows one to control movement.]

However, before the Nine Rank Angels could even regroup, another group of incarnations appeared.

"Slay them all!"

They were the incarnations on the Japanese side, led by Asuka Ren.

Appearing riding small demons belonging to the White Demons, the incarnations wielded their long swords in unison and clashed with the Nine Wind Angels.

The heads of the Nine Rank Angels were severed by the incarnations' sword strikes, and their bellies were pierced by sharp spears.

Anna Croft also swung her sword amidst that pandemonium. Previously, she only had to worry about Cha Yerin, but as the situation turned into a chaotic melee, blind spears and swords rained down from all directions.

Attacks that could not all be read by her unreliable [Future Sight]; the moment she stumbled backward, one of the Nine Rank Angels lying on the ground aimed his spear at her. It was a man in a long fur coat who deflected that unavoidable blow instead.

"What a pathetic sight, Prophet."

A long fur coat and a T-shirt with a skull on it. An incarnation Anna Croft knew well was there.

"Magician."

Jacob Martinez.

The King of Northern Las Vegas and the incarnation who had helped Kim Dokja during the 'Star Ladder' scenario.

He fired a few shots from his pistol at the head of the Ninth Order Angel lying on the floor, then put a cigarette to his lips.

"Bite them, you dogs of the North."

At Martinez's signal, the Northern mercenaries let out shouts and charged at the angels.

Anna Croft nodded in thanks and spoke in a somewhat grim voice.

"I thought you wouldn't get involved."

"I owe her a lot."

Glancing briefly toward Ji Eunyu, Martinez swung his palm at the charging lower-ranking angels. The upper body of the lower-ranking angel, caught in his [Severing Magic], tumbled across the floor.

Before long, the alliance of incarnations from various nations was gradually pushing back the forces of the angels. Outer Deities, sensing the raging stories sweeping across the battlefield, roared from all directions.

[A 'Giant Story' sprouts in the scenario!]

A roar announcing the arrival of a new giant story.

Bang Cheolsoo shouted.

"That's it! Push this far! We're clearing the way!"

Before long, the battle lines were pushed back right in front of the archangels. At this rate, the victory of the incarnations was certain.

It was then that Cha Seongwoo, who had remained silent, made a move.

"Activate the main controller."

With Cha Seongwoo's low voice, a radiance surged from his entire body.

[The story, 'Commander of the Battlefield', begins its storytelling!]

A large controller appeared before Cha Seongwoo's eyes. Even amidst the flashing spears and swords, Ji Eunyu, standing at the forefront of the battlefield, saw the scene clearly.

"Multi-control switch."

A faint bundle of links surged from Cha Seongwoo's entire body. Soon, the links connected with the Archangels.

Kugugugu.

At the same time, the Archangels, who had been observing the battle from the rear of the front line, moved.

The first to receive the order was the Archangel floating in the sky.

[The constellation, 'Guardian of the Youth and Travel', obeys the command of the Great Election.]

With Cha Seongwoo's signal, cumulus clouds covered the sky. The moment the incarnations raised their heads at the shimmering story beyond the sky, a pure white thunderbolt poured down through the cumulus clouds. A lightning strike of light that could neither be predicted nor avoided.

Kwakwakwakwak!

The center of the battlefield was reduced to ashes by the bombardment of light that indiscriminately struck both allies and enemies. Raphael yawned as if bored while looking at the pile of ashes.

[The constellation, 'Friend of Justice and Harmony', carries out the orders of the Grand Election.]

Following this, the Archangel Raguel also moved.

[I'm sorry, everyone.]

Bright orbs of light flashed from her hands. The incarnations, having already witnessed the Archangel's power, shouted as if in warning.

"Kill that angel first!"

But before the incarnations' swords could even move, Raguel's orbs flashed. [Punishment of Luminous Radiance]. The moment the Holy Energy Wave of the Great Warrior Raguel enveloped the battlefield, the incarnations facing the light screamed and covered their eyes.

"Aaaargh!"

The Archangel's power to blind those who face it. Incarnations shedding tears of blood before the apocalypse were wailing. Only a select few—those who turned away from the light or activated their own spells in an instant to dodge it—were witnessing that scene of hell.

Watching the blinded incarnations die, pierced by the spear of the Ninth Order of Angels, Cha Seongwoo moved an Archangel once again.

[The constellation, 'Lily of Aquarius', reveals its rank.]

Gabriel, standing beside Cha Seongwoo, grasped his holy relic.

A pure white serpent climbing up a sack. The moment Ji Eunyu confirmed the cross-shaped spear impaled in the serpent's mouth, she shouted.

"Everyone, get out of the way!"

「Brielle's Divine Spear, the Scales of Favor.」

With a vision that seemed to tilt the world in an instant, two scales appeared. On one scale stood the Archangels, and on the other—

「He will commit heinous destruction, yet he will destroy the mighty and the holy people.」

The incarnations stood there.

"No—"

Light swept across everything on one of the scales. An overwhelming storm of flashes purifying all the evil in the world.

Where the remnants of the light vanished, a massive path opened up. Neither the incarnations equipped with story metal nor those riding White Yao were to be seen. Bang Cheolsoo, having barely escaped the flash of wind, sat slumped there dazed, having lost an arm.

「We cannot win.」

Deep despair settled upon the shoulders of the surviving incarnations. Even though their opponents were Archangels, they thought they had a chance this time. They believed the incarnations had grown strong enough, and that the gap between the stars and humans had narrowed. But the stars were still high, and humans could only look up at them. Even in this final scenario.

Archangel Kamael, having spotted Ji Eunyu from afar, was approaching. Watching the Archangel, who was coming to pronounce her death while gripping a pure white sword, Ji Eunyu suddenly recalled the words of her writer.

「"Even if I were to die, at least one person should be able to explain this story."」

Her writer, who loved ominous jokes, spoke in her mind.

「"So please don't die, Editor-nim."」

From a distance, Cha Seongwoo, wielding the power of the Presidential Election, was staring at her.

「Prove your reading.」

Ji Eunyu slowly clenched her fist. With the very hand that had tapped the keyboard countless times, turned the pages of books, and held the pen.

"You cannot win."

Cha Seongwoo's voice sounded as if he were convinced that the ending was already written. But Ji Eunyu slowly shook her head.

「All Calamity factions can summon a higher-level 'Calamity' by sacrificing stories.」

Ji Eunyu began to read.

Cha Seongwoo's gaze wavered slightly as he confirmed the story surging in her hands.

"Are you trying to summon an Outer God?"

If the Leader of the Apostles, Ji Eunyu, were to stake herself on summoning an Outer God, she could certainly summon one that surpassed the level of a natural disaster.

However, even if such an Outer God were to arrive, it could not change the course of the battlefield this time.

[No matter what calamity comes here, it cannot stop the Nebula.]

Because <Eden> was here right now.

Ji Eunyu did not stop despite Kamael's dry warning.

Kamael frowned and swung his sword.

[A futile attempt—]

At the same time, stories flowed from Ji Eunyu's entire body. And the moment they heard the first sentence of the story, Cha Seongwoo and all the readers there realized what kind of 'catastrophe' she was about to summon.

「That catastrophe is those capable of facing a single nebula.」

With the end of a world approaching, possessing the only probability of succeeding to that end—and thus, the name that this <Star Stream> can only call 'catastrophe'.

「That story began in the 'subway'.」

Kim Dokja Company.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1020 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (10)

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The moment he read Ji Eunyu's record, even Cha Seongwoo, who had remained composed throughout, had his eyes shaken significantly.

<Kim Dokja Company>—no reader in this world could remain unfazed at the mention of that name.

[It’s just bluff.]

However, Archangel Kamael, who was not a reader, was neither flustered nor surprised.

[I know that name, too. The adversaries of the <Star Stream> who have seen the end of another worldline.]

Has that name somehow reached this worldline as well?

Kamael continued speaking with a subtle sneer.

[No matter how much it is 'Ragnarok', one cannot suddenly summon the 'Great Emperor Green'.]

In reality, despite the dedication of the snow-covered story, Ji Eunyu's record could not continue to the next sentence.

「That story began in the 'subway'.」

Even though she had recorded just a single line, Ji Eunyu felt a terrible dizziness. Her heart pounded as if it would burst, and stories dripped from her nose. As if this world would not allow that sentence to be recorded, an immense sense of probability weighed heavily upon her.

[Foolish recorder, that record cannot be completed. For it is a story that does not fit the probability of this world.]

It was just as the Archangels had said. If she proceeded with the summoning of <Kim Dokja Company> as she was, even if she succeeded in summoning the disaster like a miracle, her soul would be shattered into pieces.

「Nevertheless, there was a reason she went out of her way to undertake such an adventure.」

Perhaps she had hoped for it.

「Wouldn't a single phrase be enough to bring back all those memories?」

Even if <Kim Dokja Company> did not come here, any reader who read this phrase would inevitably recall the same moment, and would certainly be reminded of the moment they first read this story.

Not just any reader, but the 'Second Apostle' right before my eyes—

"I am sorry."

As soon as Cha Seongwoo turned away, Kamael's command was issued.

[Exterminate them.]

Just as the horde of the Nine Orders of Angels, as if they had been waiting for this moment, was about to trample the incarnations,

Kugugugu.

A violent spark struck the sky. Startled, Kamael looked up at the heavens. It was not Raphael's thunder.

[That cannot be.]

A roar echoed through the dark clouds, and something fell from the sky.

The pitch-black Archangel Raphael was falling, groaning.

[No way—]

Kamael groaned as he swiftly soared up and caught Raphael.

There are few beings capable of shooting down the Great Archangel Raphael, even if one scoured the entire <Star Stream>.

The moment Kamael saw the stories clinging to Raphael's torn wings, his expression hardened.

[Magi?]

Ji Eunyu was also looking up at the sky.

「The stories of <Kim Dokja Company> are dangerous.」

The landscape of the sky had been turned upside down by a mere phrase. Something was descending beyond the rushing probability.

「Just by reciting this one phrase, drooling beings will swarm in like a pack of wild dogs.」

【Ahahahaha!】

Someone poked their face out through the sky where Raphael had fallen, accompanied by a sharp laugh.

【Did you really intend to summon them here? Even though this world could vanish without a trace in return?】

Asmodeus emerged from beyond the swirling portal.

【We cannot let that happen. There are still so many blank pages left in this story.】

Simultaneously with Asmodeus's remark, puppets appeared from the dark clouds in the sky.

【This banquet has only just begun.】

Corrupted stars, each emitting a terrifying demonic energy—consumed by a pitch-black aura.

[The Demon King, 'Ruthless Hunter of the Heavens of Defiance', has descended upon this scenario!]

Demon King Rank 8, Barbatos.

[The Demon King, 'Lion of the Black Mane', has descended upon this scenario!]

Demon King Rank 5, Marbas.

[The Demon King, 'God of Necromancy', has descended upon this scenario!]

Demon King Rank 4, Gamigin.

[The Demon King, 'Noble of Prophecy', has descended upon this scenario!]

Vasago, Rank 3 Demon King.

Even just this much was an event enough to cause upheaval in the <Star Stream>.

Above all, Vasago, the 'Noble of Prophecy' and Rank 3 Demon King, was a Demon King famous for not moving.

Gabriel, the 'Lily of Aquarius' who had maintained silence all along, frowned and muttered.

['The Noble of Prophecy' has come?]

However, it was too early to be surprised. It was because the most powerful Demon King at the moment had revealed himself within the shimmering portal.

[The Demon King, 'Ruler of Eastern Hell', has descended upon this scenario!]

Agares, Rank 2 Demon King.

With this, the top-tier Demon Kings had all gathered on the battlefield of 'Ragnarok'.

「The scales of probability moved by <Eden> began to balance again.」

Even more surprising was the 'faction' they had chosen.

[You damned Demon Kings. Did you really choose the 'Constellation Faction'?]

As if to counter Kamael's crude curses, the cackling pronouncements of the Demon Kings could be heard through the pitch-black storm clouds.

[Didn't you bastards know your place and cling to the 'Calamity Faction' first?]

As the Demon God of Necromancy 'Gami' roared, the dead on earth rose from their places.

The incarnations and Nine Orders of Angels who had died fighting on the battlefield. They were awakening as demons.

Oooooh—!

The demons resurrected by the power of the Demon Kings wailed. While their comrades who had fought right beside them were being resurrected as beauties, the terrified incarnations screamed. Their terror and fear only made the Demon Kings' power stronger.

[Oh, my God.]

The Demon King Agares addressed the archangels on earth, speaking.

[Do you think you can be recorded in the apocalypse without us?]

With Agares's signal, the demons of the sky began to fall to the earth.

[A new giant story is stirring!]

At the center of 'Ragnarok', the battle between good and evil was beginning.

[Aaaargh!]

Demons struck by the angels' blades vanished with screams.

[Aaaargh!]

Angels pierced by the Demon King's sword collapsed, spewing blood-red stories.

At the very center of that pandemonium stood Cha Seongwoo and Ji Eunyu.

"Was this your plan from the start?"

At Cha Seongwoo's cold question, Ji Eunyu checked the message floating in the air instead of answering.

[Chaos level rising!]

A festival of good and evil intertwined. Cha Seongwoo took in the entire scene at a glance and asked again.

"Are you planning to end 'Ragnarok' like this?"

This scenario was clearly 'Ragnarok'. However, the other major constellations were absent. If a different story were overwritten before the full-scale aspiration for 'Ragnarok' was recorded, it was possible to twist the direction of the apocalypse.

"Are you planning to wage a 'Holy-Demon War' here?"

In this timeline, the 'Holy-Demon War' did not take place. This was because 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' had prevented it.

"If necessary."

The forces of good and evil were clashing in the sky and on the ground. As if unleashing pent-up desires they had never been able to fight before, they were colliding with everything they had.

"You are part of the 'Calamity Faction'. If the Demon Kings win, you will die too."

"So you must change your mind before that happens."

As Ji Eunyu raised her fist, Cha Seongwoo raised his as well.

The two clashed fists in the air almost simultaneously. Ji Eunyu's fist held a slight advantage.

Cha Seongwoo asked.

"Do you intend to try and persuade me until the very end?"

"Correcting erroneous sentences is my job."

Cha Seongwoo felt the sparks of probability surrounding him diminish compared to before. The probability he, as the acting president, had been bearing alone was being offset by the appearance of the Demon Kings.

Perhaps Ji Eunyu had foreseen this entire situation and summoned that 'Asmodeus' and the Demon King's gang.

"You must live. You need to read the next part of the story. Without readers, neither the author nor the editor has any meaning."

"…"

"Even the author wouldn't want you to die here."

The fists of the two men clashed once again in the air. This time, Cha Seongwoo held the slight advantage.

"If I give up here, Kim Dokja will die."

"That Kim Dokja is just a character."

"Because that Kim Dokja existed."

Gathering their breath once more, the fists of the two men collided.

"I am here now, too."

It was truly a duel of evenly matched strength. The two men's powers were in equilibrium, without yielding an inch.

In the narratives wrapped around their fists, the sentences they had read until now were contained intact.

A clash of interpretations where neither could be called wrong.

Shaking fists on a battlefield where even the slightest slip meant losing one's life, the two were reading the pages of the apocalypse together.

Fists crossed beyond breathtaking descriptions and thrilling explanations.

「I interpreted this sentence this way. What about you?」

Dokja asked.

「I think this way, though.」

The editor answered.

「No, that is my interpretation.」

「Since I am your editor, wouldn't I know better?」

「That is an excessively narrow-minded interpretation.」

After loving and hating stories, and having lived them through, the two finally arrived at a single question.

「Does a story belong to the 'author'?」

The usual Ji Eunyu would have nodded in agreement. She would have said that only the author is qualified to take responsibility for a story.

But at that moment, she thought of her own author.

「Does that author know the end of this world?」

How would he answer that question, indeed?

「You haven't forgotten, have you? The protagonist of this story is the 'reader'.」

Ji Eunyu nodded. If her author had been here, he would likely have read the introduction to a story instead of giving an answer.

The two opened their mouths simultaneously.

「Only I know the ending of this world.」

The two blazing stories intertwined, and a deafening roar erupted. A battlefield where breathless angels and demons had fallen.

Ji Eunyu and Agares, having glanced at Cha Seongwoo's duel, lit a cigarette and spoke.

[At this rate, there won't be a winner.]

As Agares waved his hand toward the empty air, the momentum of the battlefield stirred once again.

[It would be good to get into the main game now.]

Looking at the sky, which was rippling as if it would tear apart at any moment, Kamael shouted.

[You crazy Demon Kings—what are your schemes!]

The demonic energy in the azure sky swirled ominously.

Kugugugu!

Soon, the sky split open as if twisted, and something began to be summoned beyond the gap.

[My God. That damn bastard.]

With Kamael's sigh, the Nine Orders of Angels on Earth looked up at the sky as if entranced. Kamael shouted.

[No! Don't look, everyone!]

The eyes of the Nine Orders of Angels split open, and a red moon rose above them.

[Aaaaaaaah!]

The Nine Orders of Angels who witnessed the moon died of a fit of rage, spewing fire from their heads.

The mere acknowledgment of its existence was enough to cause the angels' incarnations to explode, unable to withstand the force.

[Bow, all of you! Avoid the gaze! It is an ancient demon!]

Along with Kamael's warning, red moonlight illuminated the earth.

「He is the Demon of Armageddon, forgotten and obscured by the Apocalypse.」

One of the demons representing 'Armageddon', alongside Abaddon, the King of Locusts and 'Ruler of the Abyss'.

The Cataclysm of Collapse—「The Falling Moon.」

Although not of the 'End-of-World' class like the Dragon of Apocalypse, he was an Outer God positioned at the very top tier among 'Natural Disaster-Class' gods.

"Mount Cloud! It is a catastrophe equivalent to a myth-grade disaster!"

Anna Croft's sharp cry.

The moment Ji Eunyu, sensing danger, retreated from the battlefield, moonlight illuminated the spot where she had stood until the end of the battle. The moment the beautiful, pale moonlight touched the ground, everything on it withered away as if drying up, scattering into dust. As if returning to the primordial particles, every being touched by the moonlight was literally collapsing.

Only death remained on the path the moonlight had traveled. Neither incarnations, nor angels of the ninth order, nor constellations. No being touched by the moonlight could escape this natural order.

"Cha Seongwoo-ssi!"

And standing at the edge of the moonlight was Cha Seongwoo.

[NOTE 1]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Still 27 +2 chapters left.Who wants to reread the side story?

# 1021 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (11)

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The moment the moonlight finally touched Cha Seongwoo's feet, archangels stepped forward as if to protect him. The moonlight enveloped the archangels.

Just as the pale death sentence fell, Cha Yerin screamed.

"No!"

No matter how great they were as archangels, they were ultimately 'narrative-grade constellations'. There was no way a narrative-grade could handle the power of a Demon God comparable to a myth-grade constellation.

It was Ye Hyunwoo who grabbed Cha Yerin as she tried to run toward her brother.

"Let go of me!"

"Yerin-ah, calm down."

Holding her, Ye Hyunwoo calmly pointed forward and spoke.

"Seongwoo is not dead."

Ye Hyunwoo's words were true.

Even in the catastrophic moonlight that shatters the stories of all beings, the Archangels remained intact. Although the outer surfaces of their wings were scorched and their fluttering feathers had disintegrated into particles, the Archangel formation did not collapse. A gentle curtain of light enveloped Cha Seongwoo and the Archangels.

「The Archangels, who are narrative-grade constellations, have absorbed the power of the Demon God.」

It was impossible by common sense. No 'narrative-grade' can stand against a 'myth-grade'. But now, the Archangels had made that impossibility a reality.

"Ji Eunyu."

Cha Seongwoo revealed himself once again between the Archangels' wings. He was speaking while gazing at the moon in the sky.

"Have you never thought about that?"

Was it a delusion? At that moment, Cha Seongwoo's voice as he opened his mouth did not sound like a human's.

"How did <Eden>, which lacks the number of 'myth-grade constellations' compared to other nebulae, become the 'Great Nebula' that everyone fears?"

Although <Eden> did possess the myth-grade Metatron and the comparable Michael, the number of 'myth-grade constellations' was still small compared to other nebulae.

"<Eden> does not need a 'Great Star'."

Since when had it begun? The archangels were clasping their hands together. Centered around Metatron at the rear, all the archangels were praying.

[The 'Giant Story' of the Great Nebula, <Eden>, begins its storytelling!]

The archangels' prayers gathered, and the story soon condensed into a single point.

There stood the Acting President of <Eden>.

Radiance surged from Cha Seongwoo's entire body, as if he had become a single star.

The moment the pale moonlight shone upon the archangels once again, Cha Seongwoo's right hand pointed toward the sky.

「The greatest light of <Eden> is the very fact that they are 'right'.」

Pointing at the moon with a movement that was neither too fast nor too slow, Cha Seongwoo recited the first line of a very ancient story.

"Let there be light."

And the vision of all beings was instantly plunged into darkness. It was a fleeting moment, yet a darkness reminiscent of eternity. And at the end of that darkness, a blinding light burst forth.

Angels, incarnations, and even demon kings were overwhelmed by that light. Some shed tears, while others felt an intense longing.

Ji Eunyu was no exception. Feeling a terrible emptiness, Ji Eunyu could not take her eyes off that light.

All they could do was stare blankly at the spot where the light had vanished like magic.

A huge hole had opened in the sky where the sublime light had swept through.

No one could accurately understand the cause and effect of that scene, but everyone clearly understood the result.

[The Outer God 'Falling Moon' exited the scenario after suffering a near-zero blow.]

A miracle that annihilated a myth-grade Demon God with a single strike. Before that immense power, all Demon Kings fell silent.

Except for Agares alone.

[Oh, <Eden>. Did you dare use that power...]

He knew the name of that light.

「The Radiance of Creation—'Prima Lux'.」

It was the light that opened the very beginning of <Eden>. That light was <Eden>'s confidence, and the reason they had no need for other 'myth-grade constellations'.

Because with this single story, they were able to defeat all 'myth-grade constellations'.

[The story, 'Commander of the Battlefield', continues its storytelling.]

[Exclusive Trait, 'Game Expert', activates!]

As Cha Seongwoo's story and trait manifested simultaneously, the morale-boosted angels began to move again.

[Kill the demons!]

The archangels linked to him also resumed the war.

[Annihilate evil.]

Ruthless good began to slaughter evil.

At the center of that stage, Cha Seongwoo looked like the Messiah of this world.
Everyone in the <Star Stream> was watching him as if entranced.

However, only Ji Eunyu gazed at him with sorrowful eyes.

"Why."

The sleeve of Cha Seongwoo's right arm fluttered as he activated the 'Radiance of Creation'.

The 'Giant Story' of Creation, which a single human could not bear.

His ■■ was confirmed due to the transfer of the previous war. Now that this fight is over, Cha Seongwoo's soul will be destroyed in the aftermath.

"Do you think he will acknowledge you if you protect him to this extent?"

"I don't need such a thing as acknowledgment."

Cha Seongwoo's chilling warning followed.

"And there is one more arm left."

The Radiance of Creation was gathering at the tip of his left hand.

"Step back. If you come any closer, I will open fire."

Even Ji Eunyu had no way to counter a power capable of returning even a myth-grade demon to the void.

Nevertheless, instead of backing down, Ji Eunyu took a step closer to Cha Seongwoo and spoke.

"The author once said something like that while crying."

"Do not come near..."

"Editor-nim, what about a certain manuscript? No matter how much I revise it, it just won't write the way I want."

Ji Eunyu recalled the expression on the face of the writer in charge as he said those words. The man who had squeezed out tears and snot while staring at the blinking cursor.

「Some stories turn even the writer who wrote them into a reader.」

Looking at that face, Ji Eunyu thought.

If even the writer cannot control this story, where on earth does it come from? Who is forcing him to write this story? By completing this story, what do the writer who wrote it, the reader who reads it, the protagonist living it, and we ultimately become?

"So, what did that guy do?"

The reader asked, and the editor answered.

"He wrote the next chapter while crying."

"…"

"Because that was all he could do."

Ji Eunyu smiled broadly.

The record resumed at her fingertips.

「That story began in the 'subway'.」

Reading Ji Eunyu's sentence, Cha Seongwoo frowned and said.

"That record cannot continue. You must know, right?"

Instead of answering, Ji Eunyu looked up at the sky.

[The Chaos level of the battlefield is rising!]

The sky was blinking violently, as if flashing.

[The Chaos level of the battlefield is rising!]

The Chaos level was rising endlessly. Due to the clash between good and evil reaching its peak, stories of chaos were overflowing.

Looking up at that chaotic sky, Ji Eunyu recalled the moment she first obtained a sponsor.

「"What is the reason I should make you my sponsor?"」

On the day she received the offer to choose 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight' as a sponsor, Ji Eunyu asked that.

「"If I choose you, what can you do for me?"」

[The constellation, 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight', says it can offer advice regarding the scenario.]

「"But I already know a lot about the scenario myself?"」

Strictly speaking, her sponsor, who came from another timeline, was incompetent.

Constrained by the limitations of probability, her sponsor could not provide her with great support, and it was difficult to provide information that she did not know at all.

Nevertheless, she chose that patron star.

[The constellation, 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight', has become your sponsor.]

It was all for today.

「There, a soldier who wanted to be righteous stood by.」

Sentences that were thought to never continue began to be written.

Just as Cha Seongwoo, with his eyes wide open, was about to open his mouth to say something, Metatron spoke.

[Shoot her.]

At the Archangel's chilling command, Cha Seongwoo shook his head violently.

"I cannot do that."

[If you do not, I will.]

Metatron's massive hand grabbed Cha Seongwoo's arm. With the sensation that his entire joint was being twisted, his left arm was forcibly moved.

"Let go of me! I am the acting president of <Eden>!"

[If you do not shoot her now.]

Cha Seongwoo's left arm trembled, overwhelmed by Metatron's power. He manifested his power to resist time and time again, but Metatron suppressed even that and spoke.

[This world will perish.]

"No!"

Despite Cha Seongwoo's desperate resistance, his arm eventually aimed at Ji Eunyu.

"Dodge!"

The prayers of the Archangel were gathering. Looking at Cha Seongwoo's left arm aimed at her, Ji Eunyu recalled the story she loved.

It was the third 'Giant Story' of <Kim Dokja Company>.

['Stage' is activated!]

[The Giant Story, 'Season of Light and Darkness', resonates with your stage.]

Her sponsor was watching over her story.

[The constellation, 'Lotus Blooming Under the Moonlight', gazes upon you.]

Watching the overflowing story, Cha Seongwoo, in a desperate voice, shouted.

"I know what you're thinking! You intend to raise the 'Chaos Level' to summon <Kim Dokja Company>, don't you!"

Currently, this place was temporarily set up as the stage for the 'Holy-Demon War'.

And the 'Holy-Demon War' was one of <Kim Dokja Company's> main battlefields.

"But even for the 'Holy-Demon War', we cannot summon all of them!"

Cha Seongwoo grasped reality more coldly than anyone else.

"If we could summon the entire <Kim Dokja Company> with this level of probability, they would have descended into this world long ago!"

Ji Eunyu knew it too.

There was probably only one member of <Kim Dokja Company> capable of descending into this battlefield.

And the being with the highest probability of descending was her sponsor.

"Your sponsor alone is impossible! The Moonlight Empress alone cannot stop this!"

Nevertheless, Ji Eunyu did not stop recording.

[It is time to let you go.]

With Metatron's command, Cha Seongwoo's left arm radiated light.

[Let there be light.]

With the incantation of a mythical archangel, a merciless barrage of light swept through everything before their eyes.

「No matter who comes from <Kim Dokja Company>, they cannot withstand that barrage.」

Cha Seongwoo despaired. His whole body trembled. He hadn't come all the way here just to witness a story like this.

"Metatron!"

Angrily, Cha Seongwoo shouted at Metatron. However, Metatron was not looking at him.

[The constellation, 'Scribe of Heaven', sighs and falls silent.]

Metatron had remained calm even when the Demon Kings, including Agares, descended, and even when the Demon God appeared.

Yet, for the first time, Metatron's expression had hardened.

As the halo of light disappeared, Cha Seongwoo looked back at the battlefield.

「...There was a man.」

Ji Eunyu's record had been cut off, unable to continue to the end. However, the moment he read that sentence again, Cha Seongwoo realized something.

It was not that the record had been left unfinished.

「There was the strongest and loneliest man in the world,」

The record was intended to be written only up to that point from the very beginning.

"No way."

The moment he saw the tail of a pitch-black coat fluttering through the halo of light, Cha Seongwoo got goosebumps.

「He was the figure he wanted to emulate more than anyone else in this world.」

The dark blade, having deflected the radiance of creation, aimed at them with a haughty aura.

It was merely a sword pointing in this direction, yet the oppressive weight felt as if an entire world were turning against them.

At the mere sight of that presence, a certain archangel recoiled, and a certain demon king turned his back and began to flee.

The moment Cha Seongwoo looked into the man's eyes, he understood why the 'Radiance of Creation' had not worked on him.

「He is the protagonist born with the 'beginning' of this world.」

As all the stars on the battlefield trembled in silence, Cha Seongwoo whispered his name softly.

[Incarnation, 'Yoo Joonghyuk', descends as the calamity of 'Ragnarok'!]

The Supreme King of the 1,864th round has finally revealed himself in the 41st round of the <Star Stream>.

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[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 1022 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (12)

"Only one person can go this time."

At Yoo Sangah's words, Lee Gilyoung and Lee Jihye were the first to raise their hands.

"I'll go."

"What nonsense! This time, I really have to go!"

Lee Gilyoung and Lee Jihye, having raised their hands simultaneously, glared at each other. Normally, this would have been the moment for Yoo Sangah to step in and mediate between the two. However, today, something was different about Yoo Sangah as well.

Looking at the portal swirling in the air, Yoo Sangah spoke.

"I'm sorry, but this time, I'll go."

It was a passage opened by none other than her own incarnation, using her own story as a sacrifice. Therefore, if Yoo Sangah said that, there was no one who could stop her.

Except for the doctor at <Kim Dokja Company>, who was more worried about her than anyone else.

"But Sangah, you're not in good condition either."

Lee Seolhwa, who had remained silent the entire time, gently wrapped her arm around Yoo Sangah's shoulder and spoke.

"Because you have been staying connected to communicate with that world."

The story's pulse could be felt through her shoulder. Yoo Sangah was not showing it, but Lee Seolhwa could clearly feel it. Yoo Sangah's state of stories was extremely unstable at the moment.

As she had been connected to the 41st round and peering into the story without a single moment of rest, the fatigue accumulated within Yoo Sangah was immense.

Lee Seolhwa added again.

"Let's send someone else this time."

"But—"

"If it is your [Lotus Platform], Sangah, it can offset the probability to some extent."

With [Lotus Seal], one of the powers of the Lotus Platform, she—or rather, another incarnation—could be disguised as her and deployed into the worldline.

The problem was who to send.

With a light sigh, Yoo Sangah opened her mouth.

"There will be powerful enemies we have never faced before. As soon as we are deployed, even the myth-grade constellations will notice."

"…"

"If Sooyoung-ssi had been here, I would have sent her..."

Yoo Sangah slowly lifted her gaze from the portal and turned around. Then, one by one, the other members of the group also looked in that direction.

In truth, everyone there knew.

「If only one person can go, the person who will go there is already decided.」

Yoo Sangah asked.

"Can you do it?"

To Yoo Joonghyuk, such a question was meaningless. But even knowing it was meaningless, she had to ask. Because they were now comrades.

"You are asking the obvious."

"Your injuries haven't healed either."

"It is no problem."

Yoo Joonghyuk removed the bandage wrapped around his torso. The wounds sustained in the fierce battle with Odin still lingered from his back to his neck.

"You know what you have to do, right?"

"To rescue Kim Dokja."

"What are you going to do?"

"I will drag him here by force."

"You can't bring him here by killing him. You know that, right?"

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been hesitating, nodded.

"You can't beat him up too much, either."

"…"

"Answer."

Instead of answering, Yoo Joonghyuk donned the 'Coat of Infinite Dimensions'. Next, he carefully wrapped bandages made by a Heavenly Master around both hands and strapped on the 'Black Heaven Demon Blade' sharply forged at his waist.

As Yoo Joonghyuk raised his head, having fully assumed his stance, Yoo Sangah spoke.

"Go, Joonghyuk-ssi. Please—"

Without even listening to Yoo Sangah finish, Yoo Joonghyuk threw himself into the portal. With a dazzling beam of light, [Lotus Platform] activated, and a lotus bud protected Yoo Joonghyuk's body.

Watching Yoo Joonghyuk vanish in an instant, Yoo Sangah muttered in a distant voice.

"Save all of Kim Dokja."

---

Oh, ohhhh...

A sound of crying was heard from somewhere. At first, it sounded like a low, faint sob, but as time passed, it gradually grew thick and resounding.

Oooooh—!

The Outer Gods who had seen Yoo Joonghyuk were wailing. Some cries were awe, while others were terrifying fear.

There were Outer Gods who writhed in the void, unable to control their emotions, and there were 'Nameless Ones' who melted away on the spot, unable to control their agitation.

The constellations were no different.

Bloody stories poured from the eyes of Yophiel, who had activated [Eyes of Sin], and the other Archangels wore dazed expressions.

[Could it be... that one is...]

Everyone was weighed down by silence. Stars who knew who Yoo Joonghyuk was, and those who did not, trembled just by meeting his gaze. Just by looking, one could recognize his presence at a glance.

「He is the one who reached the ■■ of a story that even the stars could not see.」

The stories flowing unadulterated from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire being dominated the battlefield.

[How.]

Reading those stories, Metatron sighed faintly.

[Can existence become this great merely by having seen the end of a story?]

Yoo Joonghyuk took a slow step. Even though the direction he was heading was clear, no one could stop him.

「And only one person stood in his way.」

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

It was Cha Seongwoo. From a distance, he could hear Ji Eunyu, Cha Yerin, and Ye Hyunwoo shouting something. But nothing reached his ears.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

He called out that name like a madman.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

He called out once more. Yoo Joonghyuk paid no heed to such calls and glanced at the Archangels of <Eden>.

Was Uriel absent?

As if he had completed all necessary verifications with that, Yoo Joonghyuk muttered as he walked toward the barracks.

"Kim Dokja is..."

Before Yoo Joonghyuk could even finish his sentence, the spear of light held in Cha Seongwoo's hand flew. With a sharp slapping sound, the spear bounced away. The lightly swung 'Black Heaven Demon Saber' had blocked the spear.

"The Kim Dokja you are looking for is not here."

Cha Seongwoo, positioned behind Yoo Joonghyuk, spoke in a chilling voice. The relics of the Archangels rose behind Cha Seongwoo.

'Punishment of Madness'.

'Staff of the Pilgrim'.

The relics of Raguel and Raphael activated simultaneously. A light that blinds the eyes of the living. Subsequently, a thunderous light bursting from the staff pierced Yoo Joonghyuk's face.

Swoosh.

Yoo Joonghyuk did not close his eyes even against the power of 'Punishment of Madness'. He had shattered the Archangel's power solely through the sheer physical strength of stories. The light sword strike he then swung tore apart even Raphael's thunderous light.

Of course, Cha Seongwoo had anticipated that far.

「You have seen a ram with two horns, and the great horn between its eyes is its first king.」

Gabriel's Story, 「The Revelation of the Apocalypse」.

A story that borrows the power of the apocalypse to absurdly amplify the user's story grade. The stature of divinity, which only an archangel could handle, surged through Cha Seongwoo's entire body.

「His power is bound to grow stronger by his own strength, but it is not by his own power.」

Cha Seongwoo let out a monstrous roar, accompanied by the pitch-black horns sprouting from his head. Gabriel's Divine Spear, clutched in his hand, aimed forward. The moment the spear, imbued with the light of demon slaying, flashed toward Yoo Joonghyuk, Yoo Joonghyuk muttered.

"Is it the 'Scales of Favoritism'?"

Cha Seongwoo's eyes were filled with astonishment.

A speed so fast that he could not even feel the distance closing.

Yoo Joonghyuk, having come right up to his nose, held it as if it were a child's toy. He grabbed the spear with his bare hands. The light concentrated within the spear faded with a thud.

As Cha Seongwoo screamed while gripping the divine spear with both hands, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke.

"That is not how you use this."

With immense grip strength, Yoo Joonghyuk lightly swung his arm, sending Cha Seongwoo's body spinning around and crashing into the ground.

Having snatched the spear, Yoo Joonghyuk swung it toward the sky as if testing its performance.

Kugugugugu!

A bundle of energy radiating from the spear flew straight toward the battlefield of the angels and demons. As the nine rank angels and demons struck by the energy bundle died without even being able to scream, the high-ranking demons and high-ranking angels joined the fray. They were the Archangels commanding the battlefield, and the Demon Nobles.

[Block them! No matter how great a being they are, it is merely human technique—]

The Archangel commander at the front was cut in two before he could even finish his sentence. Terrified, the angels and demons belatedly scattered to avoid the bundle of powerful energy, but the energy split apart as if possessing a will of its own, slaughtering every single one of the fleeing angels and demons.

[The power of the Giant Story, 'Holy War of Good and Evil', is beginning to weaken.]

Eventually, the archangels and demon lords who had been watching the battlefield stepped forward.

[At this rate, the 'Holy War of Good and Evil' itself will collapse!]

If the Giant Story shatters, the very reason for their descent into this 'Ragnarok' will vanish. They could not let that happen.

[It has no choice. We will join forces for a moment.]

Marbas, the highest-ranking demon lord, roared and transformed into a giant lion, while Barbatos also summoned his main fleet.

At the same time, the Archangel Kamael, clad in pure white armor, activated the Holy Relic.

[The constellation, 'One Who Faces God', activates the holy relic, 'Judgment Seat of Strict Judgment'!]

As Kamael's holy relic activated, the Trial Seat began to list Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Deadly Sins'.

「Killed every subway passenger in the first scenario.」

「Killed 64 incarnations in the second scenario.」

「In the third scenario…」

Yoo Joonghyuk's sins were listed endlessly.

Kamael's holy relic, the 'Trial Seat of Strict Judgment', imposes ceaseless 'penalties' on the target's overall stats in proportion to their sins. Due to the nature of the holy relic, which imposes stronger penalties the more evil the target, Yoo Joonghyuk's 'penalties' could stack almost infinitely.

「Destroyed 5,362 stars in the 99th scenario.」

Kamael and the Demon King met as they confirmed his incomprehensible deadly sins. It was the moment the Archangel and the Demon King, who had been gnashing their teeth at each other until the end of the war with disaster before their eyes, joined hands.

[I never thought the day would come when that Great Warrior bastard's Trial Seat would be of help.]

Barbatos loaded his battleship with magic.

[I will end this with this one blow.]

Marbas, transformed into a colossal lion, mounted Kamael, who was clad in pure white armor.

As Kamael raised his dazzling sword with all his might, the Archangels and High Demons following behind them rushed toward Yoo Joonghyuk.

[The power of the holy relic, 'Strict Judgment Seat', is manifested!]

Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation, having suffered immensely compounded penalties, was now as fragile as a sheet of paper. To finish off Yoo Joonghyuk, Barbatos's battleship spewed fire, and Kamael's sword strikes moved.

Yoo Joonghyuk gazed intently at the entire scene and swung his spear once again. A blinding light flashed, and the sound of something shattering was heard.

And.

[The constellation, 'One Who Faces God', has suffered a blow close to annihilation and exits the scenario!]

[The Demon King, 'Ruthless Hunter of the Heavens of Defiance', is exiting the scenario after suffering damage close to annihilation!]

[The Demon King, 'Black-Maned Lion', is exiting the scenario after suffering damage close to annihilation!]

It was just a single strike. Not even a strike delivered with full force, but just a spear swing swung indifferently.

[The Holy Relic, 'Scale of Favor', exhausts its power.]

Unable to withstand Yoo Joonghyuk's narrative, the bent 'Scale of Favor' rolled across the ground, discolored pitch black.

No one on the battlefield dared to open their mouths. A monster capable of slaughtering three narrative-grade constellations with a single blow. Everyone there was clearly perceiving it.

「That being that has just descended before our eyes is undoubtedly 'myth-grade' or higher.」

The next moment, Cha Seongwoo, who had been slammed into the ground, reappeared covered in dust.

"What is everyone doing?"

Cha Seongwoo shouted as if to awaken the silent battlefield.

"Eden! Get your act together! Have you forgotten whom you descended upon this battlefield to protect!"

It was then that Metatron, the scribe of heaven who had been hesitating all along, opened his book.

[The story, 'Apocalypse', begins its storytelling!]

Only Ji Eunyu recognized the greatness of that story in that very spot.

「The Archangel, standing before the apocalypse, begins his final compilation.」

Metatron's story, which had never been described even in the main story. A story that abnormally amplified the abilities of the archangels by grinding in the entirety of the

massive story of <Eden>, which had only manifested in a select few 'Holy War of Good and Evil' events.

All the archangels were enveloped in a dazzling radiance, as if they had all become a single star.

At the center of that light stood Cha Seongwoo.

[Exclusive Trait, 'Game Expert', activates!]

Controlling all the archangels with his controller, he spoke to Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You may not know me, but I know you well."

Unable to withstand the story of <Eden>, Cha Seongwoo's entire body began to burst into flames.

"Because I have lived to become you."

Using all of Cha Seongwoo's stories as fuel, the story of <Eden> began its storytelling. The archangels connected to the main controller scattered in perfect order, pouring out attacks like a single army.

Raphael soared into the sky once again and scattered thunderbolts, while Yophiel's [503 Unit] surged toward Yoo Joonghyuk. Raguel's 'Punishment of Madness' emitted light. Gabriel also aimed his broken 'Scale of Favor'.

[The constellation, 'Savior of the Fall', reveals its true power!]

Even Michael, who had remained hidden in the darkness until the very end, moved.

The single sword of Michael, the strongest battle angel boasted by <Eden>, plunged directly into Yoo Joonghyuk.

The moment the stories of the archangels destined to annihilate all life on Earth converged at a single point—

[Exclusive Trait, 'Ruler of Play', activates!]

The world's time stopped.

「No one there could understand the events that unfolded at that moment.」

The regressor, having seen the end of the scenario, gazed at the sky.

「Only the recorders realized what had happened in the blank spaces and held their breath.」

Finally reaching the 'final phase of the scenario', Yoo Joonghyuk, freed from the penalty of probability, revealed his true power.

「That record could not be written accurately. Because no recorder had ever found a sentence to accurately capture the landscape they had witnessed.」

As if engraving a single sword strike into a vast blank space, Yoo Joonghyuk's sword was drawn.

「Only the recorder who wrote this story for the first time has written a single word into that eternal void.」

Time, which had stopped, began to flow again.

「Meteor Slash.」

Cha Seongwoo looked up at the sky with vacant eyes. At that moment, Cha Seongwoo recalled the 'Radiance of Creation'.

A power utterly incomprehensible in terms of causality. A power that gauges what has happened solely by the result.

[The constellation, 'Commander of the Red Cosmos', has suffered a massive blow and is exiting the scenario!]

Now, Yoo Joonghyuk, too, was using such a power.

[The constellation, 'Lily of Aquarius', has suffered massive damage and exits the scenario!]

[The constellation, 'Friend of Justice and Harmony', has suffered massive damage and exits the scenario!]

Stars were falling from the sky.

[The constellation, 'Guardian of Youth and Travel', has suffered massive damage and exits the scenario!]

Only two stars survived.

[The constellation, 'Savior of Fallen', has suffered fatal damage!]

Michael, with his eyes wide open and his wings torn.

[The constellation, 'Scribe of Heaven', swallows a groan.]

Metatron, clutching his half-torn book.

[How dare—!]

Just as the enraged Michael was about to lunge at Yoo Joonghyuk once again, Metatron moved.

[The constellation, 'Savior of the Fall', has exited the scenario by order of <Eden>.]

As if declaring that he would no longer be involved in this matter, Metatron stepped back, lightly raising both hands.

[The Great Nebula, <Eden>, ceases the activation of all stories.]

The Nebula's 'Great story' was dismantled by a single incarnation.

Amidst the overwhelming grief of all beings witnessing this unbelievable miracle, Cha Seongwoo smiled and muttered.

"As expected."

Having exhausted all his sacred flames, Cha Seongwoo's incarnation body began to slowly crumble.

"That is the very Yoo Joonghyuk I wanted to see."

Cha Seongwoo realized. With this, his role, which would never be acknowledged by anyone, had finally come to an end. As he raised his head, gray snow began to scatter in the air. Looking closely, it was not snow.

It was his story.

Slowly, his vision darkened, and pitch-black darkness descended. In the darkness, Cha Seongwoo muttered a final line from a story he loved.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

In the darkness, he heard the sound of Yoo Joonghyuk's footsteps approaching.

「He knows, too. He can never become Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Having understood Yoo Joonghyuk better than anyone, he knew exactly what was about to happen to him.

「Because he is merely a 'reader who admired Yoo Joonghyuk'.」

Yoo Joonghyuk would likely either slaughter him mercilessly or pass by indifferently, paying no attention whatsoever.

Indeed, Yoo Joonghyuk's footsteps passed him by indifferently. The moment he wore a bitter smile, the sound vanished from his ears. He wondered if he had lost his hearing as well, but strangely, his own rough breathing was still clearly audible.

And how much time had passed?

With a shiver running down his spine, Cha Seongwoo realized.

「Yoo Joonghyuk is standing stopped beside him right now.」

From the darkness, the voice of the man he had long admired was heard.

"I know you, too."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1023 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (13)

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For over eight years, Cha Seongwoo fought alongside a man for his sake.

Snow White.

A man known to the myth-grade constellations as the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space', and to the recorders as 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

While clearing scenarios and growing alongside him, Cha Seongwoo learned many facts about Kim Dokja that he had never known before.

The Kim Dokja he followed liked tea. He often wore a melancholic smile, and would sit blankly before intently staring at his smartphone.

It didn't seem like he was reading 'Ways of Survival', so there were times when Cha Seongwoo wanted to ask him what on earth he was looking at.

When he wasn't performing a scenario, drinking tea, or looking at his smartphone—Kim Dokja was always looking up at the sky.

With eyes that made it impossible to tell what he was searching for, he gazed endlessly at the sky again and again.

「"You."」

Even on a day shortly after 'Ragnarok' began, he was gazing up at the night sky alone.

Perhaps it was because the back of Kim Dokja's head looked lonely. Cha Seongwoo said something he wouldn't normally say.

「"It seems you like the night sky."」

At that, Kim Dokja glanced back, smiled, and replied.

「"In my world, the stars weren't very visible. I find myself looking up at them every time because they are fascinating."」

「"You can't see the stars? Were you trapped somewhere?"」

「"We are all trapped. It is just that the size of the prisons we are each confined in is different."」

He would occasionally mutter such pedantic words. Whenever Cha Seongwoo heard such things, he felt the urge to smack that gloomy man hard on the back of the head.

However, it was not him who struck the back of the head first that day, but Kim Dokja.

「"Why don't you leave?"」

A question that flew in out of nowhere.

Cha Seongwoo swallowed his feigned bewilderment and said.

「"Why should I leave?"」

「"You know it by now, don't you? I am not the Kim Dokja you were hoping for."」

The Kim Dokja he had hoped for.

Cha Seongwoo ruminated on those words a few times before asking back.

「"Why do you decide that?"」

「"The Kim Dokja you are looking for is my brother. He is a being chosen as the protagonist of a world from the very beginning."」

Cha Seongwoo also knew very well who the 'Kim Dokja' he was speaking of was.

Blonde hair resembling Cheon Inho. Kim Dokja, who appeared in this world with squinting eyes.

Cha Seongwoo liked that Kim Dokja, too. He wanted to see the ending with him. He wanted to turn the final page of the story he would write together.

But eight years had passed, and now he was here. Beside another Kim Dokja, who might become his enemy.

「"The way I see it, you seem like a protagonist yourself."」

Kim Dokja gave a wry smile at Cha Seongwoo's words.

「"I thought that if we started the scenarios over from the beginning, I might be able to become like my brother."」

Cha Seongwoo thought about the scenarios he had shared with Snowfield Kim Dokja.

Snowfield Kim Dokja was incredible. He had built a story that could only be described that way.

Based on the strategy information he knew, he calmly completed the scenario with his companions and saved many incarnations. Perhaps even more characters had been saved by him than the Kim Dokja of the main story had saved.

However, not all characters were like that. The choice to save the majority was sometimes heartless toward the minority.

「"Do you regret abandoning Kyung Sein and Lee Dansu?"」

「"No. As you know, I am a heartless human being."」

「"I saw you assign a mission to Kyung Sein. I also saw you take some of the 'Kim Dokja Fragments' she possessed."」

「"..."」

「"Didn't you judge that she would be in danger if she possessed a complete fragment?"」

At Cha Seongwoo's words, Kim Dokja smiled silently.

「"I am not that kind of person."」

Is this Kim Dokja good, or is he on the side of evil?

Even with Yophiel's [Eye of Sin], Cha Seongwoo could not fathom what kind of being he was. All he could see through the [Eye of Sin] was a quiet, desolate, gray ruin.

For the past eight years, Cha Seongwoo walked and walked through that ruin endlessly. He felt that if he walked to the very end of the ruin, he would be able to understand the Kim Dokja standing before him. However, no matter how much he walked and walked for eight years, the back of Kim Dokja, who walked ahead of him, did not get any closer.

Although Kim Dokja was carrying out the scenario with him, he always seemed to be living in a different story.

As if trying to deny that sensation, Cha Seongwoo spoke.

「"Every Dokja has his own life. You have done more than enough."」

The constellations in the night sky were emitting an ominous light. The forces of the stars were gathering ahead of the final scenario.

Looking at the cluster of stars shining exceptionally brightly that day, Cha Seongwoo spoke.

「"The conclusion is right around the corner."」

Kim Dokja, too, slowly nodded his head. Soon, Kim Dokja would begin his final battle. And the Kim Dokja who won that battle would become the 'Oldest Dream' of this world.

「"If I become the 'Oldest Dream', the entire universe might become unhappy."」

「"I know the dream you desire."」

「"What is it that I desire?"」

「"Happiness."」

At Cha Seongwoo's assertion, Kim Dokja's eyes wavered faintly. Cha Seongwoo deliberately averted his gaze and continued speaking.

「"I hope your dream comes true."」

Since he was not looking at Kim Dokja, Cha Seongwoo could not see his expression. A quiet night breeze brushed against the back of his hand. Just as he was thinking that the

answer wouldn't come back, Kim Dokja answered in a low voice.

「"I, too, wish for your happiness."」

Was it because the shimmering starlight in the night sky was sad? Or was it because the final scenario was nearing its end? The moment Cha Seongwoo heard those words from Kim Dokja, he choked up without realizing it.

「"Kim Dokja, am I your comrade?"」

「"Yes."」

「"Then what I wished for has already been achieved."」

Kim Dokja remained silent for a long time after Cha Seongwoo's answer. Only after several stars had fallen from the sky did Kim Dokja open his mouth in a subtly sorrowful voice.

「"Is that really what you want?"」

At that moment, Cha Seongwoo did not understand why Kim Dokja had asked such a question. However, there are moments when one realizes that they have wanted to read a story all along only after finally reading it, and that there is a story that anyone can read, yet resonates only with me. A sentence born in a world I do not know, yet seems to explain me more accurately than anything else.

"I know you, too."

When Cha Seongwoo heard those words from Yoo Joonghyuk, he realized what he had truly desired.

「This was the reason his reading had to continue until now.」

The depths of his soul vibrated faintly. The sensation of the door leading to the story he had long wanted to know—a door that had been closed for so long—opening wide.

"Get up."

At that voice, Cha Seongwoo raised his head and felt his vision slowly return.

"At least do not die in a place like this."

In the dim light, Cha Seongwoo saw golden stories scattering before his eyes. The stories touching his cheeks were caressing him. A faint vitality was returning to his body.

Yoo Joonghyuk was scattering something he held in his hand over his head.

「It was a fragment of Yoo Joonghyuk's story.」

The story of the being he so desperately wanted to become, the one he wanted to resemble more than anyone else.

「He wanted to be acknowledged by Yoo Joonghyuk.」

The moment he acknowledged that fact, Cha Seongwoo felt a dizzying shiver pierce his mind.

He felt as though he knew what his ■■ was.

Perhaps sensing the change in Cha Seongwoo's entire body, Metatron, who had been observing the situation from a distance, widened his eyes.

「At that moment, the Acting President of Eden gained insight into all his reading.」

The act of reading a single story over a hundred times. A reader who wanted to understand a story better than anyone else, the history built with effort and obsession had caused a miracle.

「■■.」

From the very beginning of every story to the present. Cha Seongwoo felt that all the stories he had read were converging into a single conclusion.

「And so, the moment arrived when the reader's imagination surpassed the author.」

An ending already written, and simultaneously being written. A sentence beyond the gray, which even countless recorders had not reached. At that moment, Cha Seongwoo alone reached that sentence. Upon reading it, he sighed and despaired.

"...is it?"

The reason why all these stories had to flow this way. The reader, having realized all those secrets, had only one thing to say to Yoo Joonghyuk now.

"Run... away."

That was the last word Cha Seongwoo conveyed.

Tsutsutsutsu!

With a fierce spark, Cha Seongwoo's consciousness, which had barely returned, vanished completely.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at Cha Seongwoo with eyes that could not understand. He was still alive and breathing.

「He was just about to convey words that should not have been conveyed.」

Run away? It was an incomprehensible statement. Because there was no reason anywhere in this <Star Stream> for Yoo Joonghyuk to run away right now.

Rumble, rumble, rumble.

It was then that the weather in the sky changed drastically. At first, he thought the Demon Kings had summoned another insignificant Demon God. However, the sky was strangely bright for a Demon God to have appeared.

[A frag ment of the Ol dest Dream—]

It was countless stars that had dyed the sky the white night.

The constellations that had waited only for the final moment of this world, crying out for the 'Oldest Dream'.

Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Black Heaven Demon Blade' began to weep faintly. His sword was reacting to the intensity of the stars.

<Olympus>.

<The Emperor>.

<Asgard>, <Vedas>.

<Papyrus>.

Just like the final scenario of the 1,864th round, the stars filling the sky were watching him.

Yoo Sangah’s prediction was correct.

The constellations of the giant nebulae, having sensed his presence, had finally revealed themselves in 'Ragnarok'.

"I will drop you all."

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk gripped the hilt of the 'Black Heaven Demon Sword' accompanied by a chilling voice.

[A new 'Calamity' has descended upon 'Ragnarok'!]

A portal opened behind him with an ominous message.

The presence of the calamity possessed an ominous aura.

Yoo Joonghyuk instinctively drew the hilt and turned around.

"What? It works! You said only one person could go!"

At the calamity's voice that followed, Yoo Joonghyuk froze in place, clutching his half-drawn sword.

"Why are you here?"

Lee Gilyoung stood before his eyes.

[A new 'Calamity' had descended upon 'Ragnarok'!]

Then, another portal opened, and Lee Jihye, with her long hair swaying, appeared.

"Aaaah! Master! I'm here too!"

It was impossible.

Yoo Sangah had clearly said that only one person could come. But how could Lee Gilyoung and Lee Jihye descend in the scenario of the 41st round? In any case, for now, it was a win-win situation.

If there were multiple members of <Kim Dokja Company>, there was nothing to fear even if the entire 'Great Nebulae' of the 41st round turned into an enemy.

But that was not the end.

[A new 'Calamity' has descended upon 'Ragnarok'!]

[A new 'Calamity' has descended upon 'Ragnarok'!]

The air split open, and Yoo Sangah and Lee Seolhwa appeared as well. With this, all members of <Kim Dokja Company> who could currently gather were assembled in one place.

However, Yoo Sangah's expression did not look particularly happy.

"Joonghyuk-ssi, is something wrong?"

Yoo Joonghyuk, too, sensed that something ominous was happening.

The fact that they had all been summoned here as 'catastrophes' meant that the 'probability' for them to all gather here had been satisfied.

At first, he thought it was the influence of the Giant Nebulae that appeared in the scenarios. However, looking up at the sky again, he saw few mythic-grade constellations yet.

「The scales of probability are off.」

Despite the misaligned probability, no aftershocks blew around the descended <Kim Dokja Company>. There was no sign of the hounds chasing the abyss appearing either.

「That meant something existed on the opposite side of this 'scale'.」

Just as a chilling premonition brushed against his heart, Yoo Sangah spoke.

"Dokja-ssi—"

Along with Yoo Sangah's voice, Yoo Joonghyuk also suddenly realized something.

Since when had it started?

「A bright light was emanating from the tent.」

Yoo Joonghyuk and Yoo Sangah, their eyes meeting, launched themselves in unison. The sound of Ji Eunyu shouting could be heard as she followed them a moment too late. However, Ji Eunyu's voice was swallowed by the ensuing blue light.

A dazzling flash enveloped the entire ruined world. A radiance as brilliant as when Yoo Joonghyuk was summoned, or as brilliant as when the 'Radiance of Creation' of <Eden> exploded. As the blinding radiance vanished from the sky, gray snow began to fall.

"Entering."

Piercing through the swirling snow, Yoo Joonghyuk finally reached the front of the tent and reached out his hand toward the barracks. But at that very moment, someone opened the barracks.

「A man stood there with a face they remembered from a very long time ago.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, Yoo Sangah, Lee Jihye, Lee Seolhwa, and Lee Gilyoung.

「His pure white hand touched the gray snow fluttering from the sky.」

Everyone watched the scene, unable to utter a single word.

All they could do was gaze at the man, as if reading a sentence that had already been written.

The man, who had been silently looking up at the sky, slowly lowered his gaze to look at them. The faces of each person were reflected in his eyes.

[A new 'Catastrophe' has descended upon 'Ragnarok'!]

Snow White—'Snowfield Kim Dokja' has finally awakened from his slumber.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1024 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (14)

Perhaps Yoo Sangah had been imagining this moment for a very long time.

「What should I say when I meet Kim Dokja again?」

She thought of the Kim Dokja she knew.

Since he is a somewhat timid person, he might feel awkward around the group if they meet again after a long time. Therefore, she would probably have to be the one to initiate the first greeting.

「"You idiot! You're finally here?"」

The first person to approach would likely be Han Sooyoung.

Han Sooyoung, swaggering over, would have put a headlock on Kim Dokja, who was standing there blankly, and shouted.

「"How long are you going to stand there like that? Can't you see people are waiting?"」

The next person to run would likely be Shin Yoosung.

「"Ahjussi—!"」

Kim Dokja would have collapsed helplessly before the two people rushing at him without a moment's hesitation. If it were those two, they would have instantly transformed the Kim Dokja before them into 'the Kim Dokja they knew', no matter the situation.

「But Han Sooyoung and Shin Yoosung were not here right now.」

Looking at 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' appearing before her, Yoo Sangah felt an inexplicable sense of strangeness.

It felt like a button that had been fastened incorrectly from the start had been fastened all the way.

「No reunion I had ever imagined was like this.」

Yoo Sangah opened and closed her trembling lips several times.

She had so much she wanted to say when she met him. How he had been doing, whether he had been lonely, what he had eaten, whom he had met, whether his health was okay, what he had read alone.

Just as much as they, and she—had missed him—whether he, too, had thought of them.

However, Yoo Sangah could not easily bring herself to ask any of those questions.

「It felt as though there was a massive blank space before her eyes.」

A blank space covered in an overwhelming gray. Looking at that blank space, Yoo Sangah thought of Han Sooyoung.

If you had been here, what would you have said to that Kim Dokja?

The Kim Dokja she met again still had the face she remembered, yet he wore a strangely unfamiliar expression. The moment she saw him gazing up at the distant sky, Yoo Sangah was reminded of a single tree growing in a gray snowfield.

「There was always a scent of clean wood coming from Kim Dokja.」

She couldn't tell if it was his natural body odor or the perfume he wore. However, Yoo Sangah liked that scent. She liked it even more after realizing it was Kim Dokja's fragrance.

She could immediately recognize where he had been, no matter where he was. In the office, in the break room. Wherever that scent drifted to her nose, she knew Kim Dokja had been there.

「That scent didn't emanate from the Kim Dokja right in front of me.」

Perhaps Kim Dokja had lost that scent while wandering for so long. But it is only natural for people to change. Because she, and the rest of the group, had changed.

Yoo Sangah took a light deep breath and took a step closer.

Neither Han Sooyoung nor Shin Yoosung were here. Therefore, she was the only one who could reach out to him first right now.

The moment she mustered the courage to take another step, someone grabbed her shoulder. It was Ji Eunyu.

"He is not the Kim Dokja you know."

Yoo Sangah nodded in reply.

"It is Dokja-ssi."

As she said this and looked ahead again, someone was standing in front of Kim Dokja, ahead of her.

It was Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Kim Dokja."

However, despite Yoo Joonghyuk's call, Kim Dokja did not look at him. As if he hadn't heard his voice.

"Kim—"

When Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth once more, Kim Dokja moved first. Kim Dokja leisurely brushed past him as if he hadn't seen him. And surprisingly, Yoo Joonghyuk could not stop Kim Dokja as he passed right beside him. As if some powerful story were binding him.

Yoo Joonghyuk simply brushed past Kim Dokja and stood frozen in place. Kim Dokja stopped only after walking ten, then twenty more steps past Yoo Joonghyuk.

There lay Cha Seongwoo, collapsed.

"So it ended up like this?"

Muttering in a quiet voice, Kim Dokja lifted the fallen Cha Seongwoo into his arms. At that, Cha Seongwoo blinked, spitting out a weak story.

"I told you to run away. I clearly told you that you would die if you stayed here."

Kim Dokja's strangely subdued tone sounded both sad and lamenting.

As he examined Cha Seongwoo's condition, Kim Dokja seemed to realize exactly what had happened.

"Did you borrow the power of <Eden>?"

From a distance in the sky, he could see Metatron, whose eyes met his, gasp in surprise. Kim Dokja turned his head away as if Metatron wasn't even worth gazing at, and spoke to Cha Seongwoo again.

"It seems even the Holy Oil won't be enough to heal you this time."

Cha Seongwoo's incarnation body, which had seemed to be recovering briefly thanks to Yoo Joonghyuk's story, was collapsing once more.

Cha Seongwoo's lips twitched as if to answer Kim Dokja. His incarnation body was so severely damaged that his mouth could not utter proper words.

Nevertheless, Kim Dokja listened to his story. He listened until he could hear the words that were unheard.

Cha Seongwoo's face was reflected in Kim Dokja's eyes.

「Cha Seongwoo is a reader, who can only exist in this world in the form of 'possession'.」

He does not know Cha Seongwoo's true face. Nevertheless, just as one reads the hidden implications in a sentence, Kim Dokja read the real Cha Seongwoo beyond the person named 'Kang Ilhoon'.

Finally, when Cha Seongwoo's lips closed, Kim Dokja answered.

"I see. You know everything now."

Cha Seongwoo nodded.

「Finally, there is only one person who knows his end.」

As if merely telling him that was enough, Cha Seongwoo said nothing more. His limp wrist was slowly breaking.

Kim Dokja looked at Cha Seongwoo and said.

"Do you have any last words?"

The moment he said that, someone rushed toward them. A claw imbued with sharp energy. Kim Dokja, holding Cha Seongwoo, lightly dodged the attack and spoke.

"Yerin-ssi."

Instead of answering, Cha Yerin swung her claw. A fierce killing intent surged from her entire body, as if she wanted to tear him to shreds and kill him on the spot. Within that killing intent lay deep resentment toward Kim Dokja.

「It's because of you.」

Kim Dokja silently accepted her gaze and nodded.

"That is correct. It is because of me."

Ahhhh— With a roar, Cha Yerin burst into tears.

「Bring Oppa back to life.」

"It is a shame, but it is impossible for me right now. So—"

Watching Cha Yerin run toward him, Kim Dokja added.

"Take revenge on me."

As if she had been waiting for this moment, Cha Yerin slammed her claws down. From a distance, Ye Hyunwoo shouted.

"Yerin-ssi! No!"

With a deafening roar, the figures of the two were engulfed in dust. Amidst the swirling, pitch-black dust, Kim Dokja's voice could be heard.

"Dan."

Cha Yerin's claws were held in Kim Dokja's sharp hand.

"Not now."

Kim Dokja tossed Cha Yerin into the air. The moment the powerless Cha Yerin regained her balance in mid-air, Kim Dokja's right hand moved, as if clearing unnecessary material from the story out of sight.

"Please disappear for a moment."

At the same time, space-time split open, and Cha Yerin's body was sucked into somewhere.

A power capable of banishing an incarnation, capable of fending off even a narrative-grade constellation, with a mere wave of the hand.

While everyone was astonished by that power, only Kim Dokja spoke to Cha Seongwoo in a calm voice.

"Don't worry. She has gone to a safe place 'outside' this context."

As if he already knew, Cha Seongwoo's head moved slightly.

Kim Dokja asked again.

"Where are you going?"

Cha Seongwoo's lips parted once more. Hearing his answer, Kim Dokja smiled with sorrowful eyes.

"No, this is not where you belong. Because you—"

His soul was sucked out of Cha Seongwoo's completely shattered incarnation body.

"It wasn't me, it was my 'comrade'."

Kim Dokja teleported his soul somewhere, as if guiding it. Cha Seongwoo's soul twinkled and hovered above his head for a moment, then vanished across the scenario, following a shooting star in the night sky.

Kim Dokja watched the spot where his soul had vanished for a moment before slowly opening his mouth.

"Well then, shall we introduce ourselves again?"

Despite Kim Dokja's bright voice, the members of <Kim Dokja Company> remained frozen, unable to say a word.

"I suppose it would be best if I greeted you first. It's been a long time, everyone. Surely you haven't forgotten me already, have you?"

The first to respond to that nonchalant tone was Lee Jihye.

"Really... is this really Dokja ahjussi?"

It was clearly the exact same face as the Kim Dokja she knew. However, Lee Jihye seemed unable to shake off a strange sense of unease.

Kim Dokja grinned at Lee Jihye and said.

"Well. What do you think? Jihye-ah."

Lee Jihye's shoulders trembled at the familiar sound of her name ringing out. The next to step forward was Lee Gilyoung.

"Hyung."

Eyes that wanted to run to him right then and there. But the boy, now a young man, instead of running, quietly observed his face from a distance.

"Right, Gilyoung-ah."

Getting courage from his answer, Lee Gilyoung spoke.

"You are my hyung, but not really my hyung."

Kim Dokja smiled.

"That's right."

Then, Kim Dokja turned his head toward Lee Seolhwa. He did not exchange a single word with her. Instead, the two looked at each other for a moment, then quietly exchanged a nod.

Lee Seolhwa looked at him with a sorrowful gaze, then took a step back with a deep sigh. And someone stepped forward the same distance she had taken back.

It was Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk gazed at the spot where Cha Seongwoo's soul had vanished and asked.

"Where did he go?"

"He went to where his 'real Kim Dokja' is."

The real Kim Dokja. Even with the same word, the impact it carries changes depending on who says it.

At those words that burst from Kim Dokja's lips, <Kim Dokja Company> fell silent, as if speechless people. It was Yoo Joonghyuk who broke the silence once again.

"You are Kim Dokja."

A voice filled with unwavering conviction. It was a voice so powerful that even someone who wasn't Kim Dokja would have no choice but to believe they were Kim Dokja upon hearing those words.

Kim Dokja smiled bitterly and said.

"Yes. I knew you would say that."

Yoo Joonghyuk nodded.

"It is time to go back."

"Where to?"

"Home."

"Home?"

Kim Dokja repeated the word with somewhat dazed eyes.

"When you hear that word, what kind of scenery comes to mind?"

This time, even Yoo Joonghyuk couldn't find the words to answer. To begin with, answering this kind of question wasn't something he was particularly good at. That is

why Yoo Joonghyuk turned to look at Yoo Sangah. The moment their eyes met, Yoo Sangah nodded and stepped forward, Kim Dokja spoke again.

"Only a vast, gray snowfield comes to mind."

It was a voice that seemed to lower the temperature of the world.

"If you have come this far, you all know, don't you? What kind of Kim Dokja I am. What stories have I gone through to get here?"

Yoo Sangah stepped forward and nodded. She was about to speak. She intended to say that she knew who he was, and that she had come this far because she knew. But the moment she was about to speak, a fundamental question settled in her mind.

「Do they really know who 'Kim Dokja' is?」

Amidst the spreading chill, Kim Dokja smiled as if he had expected it.

"I ask you, <Kim Dokja Company>."

The sound of flowing stories was heard from somewhere.

Sensing the presence of the stories, Yoo Sangah looked at Yoo Joonghyuk. Yoo Joonghyuk, too, realized something and was about to shout.

「Once a question is asked, it can never return to the time before it was asked.」

However, amidst the swirling stories that resembled a predetermined [fate], Kim Dokja finally asked that question.

"Do I even have a 'home' to return to?"

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1025 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (15)

Yoo Sangah groaned, instinctively wrapping her arms around herself against the biting cold. She felt the cold? It was impossible.

「Kim Dokja's stories were engulfing the surroundings.」

The stories of the entire area surged violently. Yoo Sangah instinctively realized that something dangerous was happening.

A raging, pure white snowstorm.

In that desolate landscape, only a single word came to mind for every being.

「Home.」

The stars in the empty sky blinked anxiously.

Lee Jihye, her eyes clouded by time, staggered and muttered.

"Dokja ahjussi, all alone like this—"

Lee Jihye and Lee Gilyoung, their lips pale, limped toward Kim Dokja. Yoo Sangah stopped the two of them.

"Jihye-ah. Gilyoung-ah."

At the same time, Yoo Joonghyuk's magnificent story began to unfold, waking the party members. Lee Gilyoung and Lee Jihye, who had come to their senses belatedly, stood beside the two in panic.

Yoo Joonghyuk protected the group while gazing at Kim Dokja calmly. Something ominous was unfolding in the sky surrounding Kim Dokja.

[All the stars of the scenario begin to dream an ancient dream!]

The stars in the night sky, intoxicated by the story, groaned from all directions. Some stars uttered unintelligible dialects, while others writhed in agony as if having a nightmare. At that moment, they looked more like Outer Gods than constellations.

Amidst the gray void that had settled, all the stars were looking at the same ■■.

「The stars all wanted to return home.」

Home. That place was where the first star was born—and where the beginning and end of this entire tragedy were decided.

[Everyone, snap out of it!]

What awakened those stars was the shout of a myth-grade constellation. Along with the strong scent of salt wafting from somewhere, the sound of crashing waves could be heard.

[The constellation, 'Spear That Draws the Boundaries of the Seas', has descended upon the scenario!]

One of the main constellations of the constellation faction. The myth-grade constellation of the <Olympus> side—Poseidon—made his appearance. Behind him, the great 12 Divine Thrones boasted by <Olympus> stood in formation as if guarding him.

Athena, the spokesperson of justice and wisdom.

Hephaestus, the blacksmith of the volcano.

Hebe, the goddess of youth.

Artemis, the hunter of pure moonlight.

Hestia, the mistress of the hearth and benevolence.

Hermes, the master of the celestial stride.

Also present was Apollo, the 'Almighty Sun', who had been born anew.

Next to <Olympus>, the constellations of <Asgard> stood in a line likewise.

Thor, the thunder of Thursday.

Freya, the goddess of love and cats.

Bragi, the god of the harp and horn.

Tyr, the one who lost an arm to the wolf of destruction.

With the mythical constellations standing as his guards, the God-King of <Asgard> finally revealed himself.

Odin, the one-eyed father.

Behind <Asgard> stood the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors of the <Emperor> and the Lokapalas of <Vedas>.

However, the <Emperor> and <Vedas> seemed reluctant to intervene fully, appearing to observe the situation from a few steps back compared to the other nebulae.

Stepping forward in their place was <Papyrus>, which had remained silent while conserving its strength.

[Scribe of the heavens, did you attempt to complete the 'Record' behind our backs?]

Appearing to rebuke Metatron, who had been standing to one side, was the mythical constellation of <Papyrus>—'Lord of Abydos'—Osiris. Osiris possessed a colossal mummy incarnation woven from fourteen fragments.

As Osiris gestured, a river overflowed from deep underground, and schools of fish surged forth. Above the swirling schools of fish, the representative deities of <Papyrus> revealed themselves one by one.

Anubis, the Black Wolf Grim Reaper.

Geb, the Ruler of Earthquakes and Volcanoes.

Sekhmet, the Goddess of Slaughter.

Nephthys, the Goddess of Night and Funerals.

At the same time, a dazzling star radiated its brilliance behind them.

[O Arrogant Dream, the time has come to fulfill your promise.]

The mythical constellation, 'Noon Sun'— Ra.

[The starlight of the Great Nebula floods across the <Star Stream>!]

As the mythical constellations representing the 'Round Table' gathered in one place, even the Outer Gods of the Calamity faction began to writhe in agony. The aura of the distant constellations had begun to threaten even the true bodies of the Outer Gods on the other side of the dimension.

「This was the true power of the Great Nebula.」

Not all myth-grade constellations of the 'Round Table' had gathered.

<Tamra>, <Hongik>, and some other myth-grade constellations belonging to the Great Nebula did not participate.

Nevertheless, the 'myth-grade constellations' gathered here constituted an overwhelming majority, sufficient to represent the will of the Round Table.

[Master of the Erased Blank Space, it is time to hand over the 'Final Record' to us.]

Even <Kim Dokja Company>, which had already faced the stars in the final scenario, could not hide its tension this time.

At the overwhelming aura revealed by the myth-grade constellations, all the Outer Gods of the Calamity Faction squirmed like dried-up worms in a drought.

It was Kim Dokja who stepped forward as if to protect those Outer Gods.

"Yes, I certainly made such a promise."

Surprisingly, Kim Dokja was not intimidated in the slightest by the stature of the myth-grade constellations. On the contrary, as he continued to speak, the calamities that had been stuck to the ground began to regain their vitality one by one.

"But not now. The final stage hasn't opened yet."

[Your final stage is here.]

The stars in the night sky glowed as if they were about to tear Kim Dokja apart at any moment.

At this very moment, their purpose was clear.

「They came here to possess the 'Oldest Dream'.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, who had been observing the situation, spoke to Kim Dokja.

"No matter who you are, you cannot handle all of them."

Yoo Joonghyuk's words were not wrong from a common-sense perspective. On the other side were the leaders of the 'Great Nebulae', who had led their entire full power. If they were to truly manifest their 'Giant Stories', it would be difficult for even Kim Dokja to remain safe.

"Do you really think so?"

The moment Yoo Joonghyuk saw Kim Dokja's faint smile, he felt a deep sense of disorientation in his soul.

「Have I ever, even once, witnessed the power of Kim Dokja, who has become the 'Oldest Dream'?」

Come to think of it, Yoo Joonghyuk had never yet seen the true power of Kim Dokja, who had become the 'Oldest Dream'. This was because Kim Dokja had never once exercised his authority against his companions.

"Foolish stars, you cannot stop me."

With Kim Dokja's declaration, the air in the area felt thinning.

The narrative-grade constellations, their stature diminished by a mere single remark, groaned and stepped back. Despite being under the protection of the 'Great Nebulae', they felt burdened by meeting Kim Dokja's gaze.

However, the constellations had not come seeking him without preparation.

Poseidon raised his trident and unleashed a spell.

[O <Asgard>, prepare for destruction!]

At the same time, Odin of <Asgard> stepped forward.

Yoo Joonghyuk narrowed his eyes upon seeing Odin.

Perhaps due to the fierce battle with Yoo Joonghyuk, a long, lightning-patterned scar remained on Odin's exposed upper body.

As if recognizing Yoo Joonghyuk, Odin stared at him with an unreadable gaze before speaking.

[I will now begin the prophecy of the Great Destruction.]

Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardened.

「Originally, 'Ragnarok' does not unfold in this manner.」

Yoo Joonghyuk, more than anyone else, knew the sequence in which the 'Ragnarok' scenario unfolded.

「A great wolf shall descend, and the Serpent of the World shall rise from the sea.」

「The King of Hell, freed from bondage, shall return, and the Giant of Fire shall burn everything.」

That was the order of destruction that had to unfold in 'Ragnarok'.

However, the Nebulae were now ignoring all those procedures and attempting to appropriate only a part of that prophecy.

「The King of Hell, freed from bondage, shall return.」

The One-Eyed Father, Odin, looked down at Kim Dokja.

[If you had truly become the 'Oldest Dream', this method would not have worked.]

His calm pronouncement continued, as if reciting a predetermined fate.

[No matter how great your power, you too are now merely a character in this 'scenario'.]

The moment Odin's Gungnir aimed at Kim Dokja, the record of a giant story fell upon his head.

[The Master of <Asgard> targeted the target as 'Hell' and designates him as 'King'.]

With a roar, an ominous aura began to surge through Kim Dokja's entire body. It was a shock so intense that merely standing beside him felt like it would turn one's stomach.

Lee Gilyoung, his face turning pale, muttered.

"Sangah noona, this feeling, surely—"

Yoo Sangah nodded. They had already witnessed once the overwhelming aura emanating from Kim Dokja's entire body.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja was now exuding an aura similar to that of the Kim Dokja who had become the 'Enemy of the Story' in the final scenario.」

Yoo Sangah shouted as she fully unfurled her [Lotus Platform].

"No!"

However, as if they had already anticipated the joining of <Kim Dokja Company>, the myth-grade constellations gave an order.

[Block them.]

A group of narrative-grade constellations surrounded Yoo Sangah, Lee Gilyoung, and Lee Jihye as if encircling them.

And once again, the probability of <Asgard> moved.

[Ultimately, it will be our stars that are recorded last.]

Once designated as a 'Great Cataclysm', an existence can never shake off that mark.

Furthermore, those who bear this mark cannot escape the stage of the 'Giant Story.'

「The 'Hell' of the Cataclysm Faction, the 'King' shall perish together with the 'Star of Prophecy' of the Constellation Faction.」

Along with the ensuing [Fate], a shining constellation appeared from the <Asgard> faction.

Heimdal, the Guardian of the Great Horned Legs.

He was the protagonist of <Asgard> who would execute this [Fate].

「In the original 'Ragnarok', Heimdal, the 'Star of Prophecy', will fight Loki, the 'King of Hell', and perish together.」

Gazing into Heimdal's clear eyes, Kim Dokja smiled faintly.

"You have prepared an interesting stage."

The constellations' plan was clear. They intended to realize the [Fate] of the 'Giant Story' and cause Heimdal and 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', who had become the new King of Hell, to perish together right here.

"Do you think he is on the same level as me?"

As Kim Dokja slowly rose to his feet, the stars in the area stirred greatly.

「In order to achieve a 'stage of scale', the two contenders must be of equal standing.」

However, the myth-grade constellations showed no signs of panic whatsoever, as if they had prepared for even that.

[Bring me the fragments.]

At Odin's command, the stars moved. As the portals opened, the myth-grade constellations of each nebula appeared, carrying massive 'cages'.

The moment he saw the cages, even Snowfield Kim Dokja, who had remained serene throughout, changed his expression.

"You... surely not."

A look of unmistakable rage.

Inside the cages were the 'Kim Dokja fragments' that the constellations had gathered until now.

Aaaaaaaah.

As soon as the scenario began, the little Kim Dokjas trapped in the cages burst into agonizing cries.

[Inject.]

With Odin's command, the stars' brutal hands pulled the little Kim Dokjas out. In the split second before <Kim Dokja Company> or Snowfield Kim Dokja could react, tragedy unfolded in an instant.

The moment Odin's Gungnir flashed, the little Kim Dokjas turned into mythical creatures, unable to even scream. The intermingled stories of Kim Dokja flowed into Heimdal's body under Odin's guidance.

[The constellation, 'Guardian of the Great Horned Leg', reaches a new rank!]

Amidst a tremendous storm of stories, Heimdal's incarnation body shattered. Heimdal's status, having transcended the rank granted by the power of the 'Kim Dokja Fragment', was undergoing a cataclysmic transformation.

Soon, his rank overturned even the distant landscape of the heavens.

[A new 'myth-grade constellation' has appeared in the <Star Stream>!]

Along with enchanting rays of light, Heimdal's entire body surged with the overflowing energy of the 'Oldest Dream'.

Odin opened his mouth.

[Heimdal, defeat the 'King of Hell'.]

As if responding to Odin's command, Heimdal stepped forward.

At that, the Outer Gods of the Calamity Faction, who had remained silent until now, also began to move. It was an instinctive movement to protect Kim Dokja, who had become the 'King of Hell'.

[The 'Stage' begins!]

The constellations in the sky emitted a bright light. Ahead of the confrontation between the two factions, Odin, standing at the forefront of the constellations, declared.

[Gods, let us begin the final war.]

Finally, the Twilight of the Gods—'Ragnarok'—opened its curtain.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1026 Episode 62 Snowfield Kim Dokja (16)

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[Go—!]

The stars, aligned in formation, began to descend from the sky. As all the stars in the area fell toward the ground, a spectacular scene unfolded, appearing as if the entire night sky were pouring down.

[Giant Nebula, <Papyrus> uses the probability of 'Giant Stories'!]

[Giant Nebula, <Olympus> uses the probability of 'Giant Stories'!]

[Giant Nebula, <Asgard> uses the probability of 'Giant Stories'!]

The density of the Giant Stories flooding the scenario far exceeded what ordinary incarnations could handle.

Even though the status of all the incarnations here had risen enough to enter the 'Final Scenario', some incarnations began to gag or faint just from existing within the scenario.

"Gather everyone!"

With Ji Eunyu's command, the surviving incarnations of the Disaster Faction gathered in one place. It was the best course of action for the weak to protect themselves from the flooding of stories.

As the incarnations formed a defensive formation to gather the stories, they gained enough strength to barely catch their breath even amidst the overwhelming density of the stories.

But that was as far as it went. No one dared to fight amidst that chaotic landscape.

Asuka Ren of Japan, Jacob of North America—all the heroes of humanity—were left speechless before the raging waves of stars.

"Is this the end?"

As Kim Nakmun, the Insightor who had led the incarnations alongside Ye Hyeonwoo at Gwanghwamun, cried out in despair, the beggars and soldiers of the Beggar's Sect, who had joined forces with the Inho Group hoping for a final reversal, also knelt. Mujeong and her daughter, and Bang Cheolsu as well. Everyone simply looked up at the sky where stars were pouring down.

「Those stars were the <Star Stream>.」

The gaze that moves this world, and the very probability of the universe. No matter what calamity descends, it will be unable to stop the armies of those stars.

[The probability of the Great Nebula joins the constellation 'Guardian of the Great Horned Leg'!]

At the center of those constellations stood the protagonist of this battlefield.

Heimdal, having ascended to the rank of a myth-grade constellation, blew the trumpet of doom.

「Lar Horn.」

The sacred horn, said to resound across all nine worlds of <Asgard>, signaled the outbreak of war.

At the same time, a sword enveloped in rainbow-colored radiance emerged from within the horn.

「Guardian's Sword—Hophud.」

As Heimdal's sword, which hunts calamities, emitted light, the 'Nameless Ones' leaping from the ground vanished without even being able to scream.

It was the 'King of Hell' who parried the incoming sword strike. Taking a light breath, Kim Dokja—Snow White—radiated power and spat out a mantra.

[Block!]

With a roar, the surface of the earth shook, followed by the Outer Gods that had been crouching underground roaring and rising to their feet.

[The otherworldly deity, 'One Who Swims Beyond the End', reveals its rank!]

An Outer God reminiscent of a giant jellyfish.

[The otherworldly deity, 'One Born from the Rift of Records', reveals its rank!]

An Outer God reminiscent of a crocodile.

[The otherworldly deity, 'One Who Observes the Context of the Stars', reveals its rank!]

Finally, even a cylindrical Outer God with large eyes.

The constellations, realizing their true nature, cried out in astonishment.

[How could those calamities—]

The One Who Swims Beyond the Adversity.

The One Born from the Rift of Records.

The One Who Observes the Context of the Stars.

They were all 'Outer Gods' classified as 'Interstellar Predators'. Outer Gods, each and every one of them akin to a 'catastrophic fear'. Parasitic in the gaps between scenarios, they are like the antlions of the <Star Stream>, devouring stars that have fallen out of the 'constellations' context'.

As the constellations, witnessing them for the first time in their lives, trembled in terror and retreated, the myth-grade constellations took the lead and encouraged the stars.

[Kill them. Even so, here they are merely 'catastrophes'.]

In the past, 'catastrophic fears' were monsters that even myth-grade constellations were reluctant to face.

But today was different. Backed by the stories of the 'Great Nebulae', the stars feared no Outer Gods in the universe.

「Fear of Outer Deities is merely a story of a world without 'scenarios'.」

The constellations' hunt began.

「Under the night sky where every record is crystal clear, there is no darkness that the light of the constellations cannot illuminate.」

Under the baptism of pouring starlight, the catastrophic aliens began to let out terrifying screams.

Gaaaaaah—!

Heimdal, wearing a faint smile as if quite satisfied with the screams, quietly descended before Kim Dokja.

[Master of the Erased Blank Space, your story ends here.]

The Hophus held in his right hand emitted an intense light.

[Die with the twilight within our myth.]

A storm of starlight arose from the sword strike of Hophus. A sword strike that narrowly grazed him sliced through Kim Dokja's bodice with a slashing sound.

However, Kim Dokja showed no sign of panic whatsoever. Instead of staring at Heimdal, he glared at Odin in the void and spoke.

[Odin.]

Odin, receiving Kim Dokja's gaze from the empty air, flinched. Kim Dokja continued speaking.

[You made a mistake. If you truly wanted to kill me, you should have become the 'Star of Prophecy' yourself, not Heimdal.]

An ominous current began to surge through Kim Dokja's entire body.

[If you truly wanted to kill me—you should have challenged me with only the 'stories you yourselves built'.]

Heimdal narrowed his eyes as he watched Kim Dokja's stature expand before his eyes.

[You are too arrogant, Lord of Hell.]

Heimdal was confident. No matter how much his opponent was the 'Fragment of the Oldest Dream', they were now on this 'stage'. At least as long as this 'stage' remained, he would not be defeated by the 'King of Hell', even if they were to perish together.

「Even if he were to die here, his great achievements would remain in the final records.」

However, the 'King of Hell'—Kim Dokja—did not seem to think so.

[Ragnarok is a momentous event for you stars.]

The overseer was looking at Heimdal before him. However, what he was truly looking at was not 'Heimdal'.

[But in the long history of the <Star Stream>, it is merely 'destruction'.]

What he was staring at was the very 'Giant Story' of <Asgard> surrounding Heimdal.

[The Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' is greatly stirred!]

The Giant Story of <Asgard> was agitated in response to his gaze.

Startled, Heimdal reflexively swung his sword.

[A meager trick!]

A rainbow-colored blue surged once again from his swordplay. The sky split open, and the portal of <Asgard>—Bifrost—opened.

As the gate connecting dimensions opened, the stories of the Nine Worlds poured down from the sky like a waterfall. Heimdal’s sword strike, having fully embraced the story, fell slowly forward. As if falling forward unable to overcome the gravity of the story, Hopes split the earth just as it was. Slow but certain, a strike no one could avoid.

「It is a strike that holds the beginning and the end of <Asgard>.」

A rainbow-colored flash, reminiscent of the 'Glory of Creation' from <Eden>, obliterated everything in front of Kim Dokja.

「End of Ragnarok.」

Outer Gods, constellations, and earthly incarnations alike watched the scene, unable to take their eyes off it.

Everyone in the scenario was moved by the story of <Asgard> unfolding like a panorama.

Oh, ohhhh—!

Who could possibly receive this great story? What star could dare assert that it truly understands this story?

Even after the light faded, the constellations remained intoxicated with rapture.

「This is the end of this world.」

Even Heimdal, who had delivered that blow, could not contain his rage.

「He will be recorded as a great star in the final battle of this world.」

To be precise, that was the case until that message was heard.

[The supreme constellations of the nebula, <Emperor>, are preparing to deviate from the scenario!]

At first, he thought it was a message heard incorrectly.

[The supreme constellations of the nebula, <Veda> are preparing to deviate from the scenario!]

The moment he confirmed the following message, Heimdal suddenly looked up. Several stars in the night sky were deviating from the scenario. The stars of <Asgard>, including Odin, were still holding their ground, but for some reason, their complexions looked pale.

Why on earth?

The moment he confirmed the true nature of the catastrophe that had strode out through the radiance, Heimdal was utterly shocked.

[The calamity, 'King of Hell', gazes upon you.]

Kim Dokja, having been struck directly by the 'End of Ragnarok', appeared completely unharmed. As if the flash itself had never happened, Kim Dokja stood before him with a composed demeanor.

[How, on earth—]

It was an attack that even the beings before him, if they were myth-grade constellations of the 'Giant Nebulae', could never withstand.

[There is one absolute law for all 'Kim Dokjas' who borrow the power of the 'Oldest Dream'.]

Kim Dokja looked at Heimdal with indifferent eyes, then raised his left hand, imbued with a sublime light, and spoke.

[A 'Kim Dokja' with 'fewer fragments' cannot resist a 'Kim Dokja' with 'more fragments'.]

Kim Dokja's right hand was also covered in the same light. Subsequently, Heimdal felt his body rising into the void. Something invisible was oppressing his entire being, as if binding it. As the strength drained from his right hand, Hopus fell limply to the floor. He was completely immobilized, like a prisoner hanging from a gallows.

Following this, an unbelievable message appeared before Heimdal's eyes.

[All your stories yield before the overwhelming difference in rank.]

[What is this?]

It couldn't be. No matter how great a divine being was, they could not restrain him, who wielded the power of the 'Giant Nebulae'. Yet, such an incomprehensible event had occurred. Even stranger things happened a moment later.

Tsutsutsutsu.

The 'Kim Dokja fragments' that had been absorbed by him were raging wildly, trembling violently. Soon, shattered fragments leaked out into the air, starting from his fingertips.

[Your 'rank' is wavering precariously!]

The spilled fragments immediately began to fly toward Kim Dokja, as if pulled by a massive gravitational pull. Only after seeing the fragments being sucked into Kim Dokja's hands did Heimdal belatedly realize what had happened.

「The fragments are being stolen.」

Sensing the danger, Heimdal uttered a command with all his might.

[Strike! Kill him immediately!]

With Heimdal's signal, the portal of Bifrost opened once again. And the strategic weapons of the Nebula, scattered across the nine worlds of <Asgard>, began to gather.

「Giant Story Weapon.」

An invention of the gods capable of annihilating a world. The warships designed to hunt for super-large outer deities revealed their majesty beyond the portal.

"Kim Dokja!"

This time, Yoo Joonghyuk drew his Black Heaven Demon Blade without hesitation.

The moment the battleship's cannons, having finished charging, opened fire toward the ground.

[The story, 'Dream of the Snowfield', begins its storytelling.]

The story began.

「Ash snow began to fall from the sky amidst a landscape where time seemed to have stopped.」

In the slow flow of time, only the myth-grade constellations and <Kim Dokja Company> realized a certain truth.

「Before long, the entire landscape had turned into a snowfield.」

A chill so intense that even breathing was painful. On that cold snowfield, Yoo Joonghyuk felt an inexplicable longing.

A world that felt familiar, despite being a landscape he was clearly seeing for the first time.

Yoo Joonghyuk was certain he knew this world.

「Standing there was Kim Dokja, the one closest to the 'Oldest Dream'.」

Standing in the center of the gray snowfield, Kim Dokja looked up at the stars. The moment they received that infinitely lonely and solitary gaze, every star in the scenario trembled.

「Thus, the stars realized the reason for their existence.」

Hearing an ominous premonition, the myth-grade constellations attempted to escape. However, some irresistible force held them back. An absurdity that no one could stop was being written into a story.

「The reason they were born as 'stars' and had to illuminate this lonely universe.」

As if pouring out all the light they possessed, every star in the night sky twinkled in unison. It felt as if eons of day and night were passing in an instant.

The only being capable of explaining all the causality of the world opened their mouth.

[I.]

There stood a universe born solely to be read.

[I want to stop reading you.]

And from somewhere, the sound of a page being torn was heard.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1027 Episode 63 Ragnarok (1)

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Every story exists to explain something. Some stories explain humans, while others explain emotions. Just as there are stories that explain concepts, there are also 'giant stories' that seek to explain the universe encompassing all worlds.

And here, right now, there is a story that explains all stories.

The story of stories, the giant story of giant stories.

Regarding that story written to speak the unspeakable, the great recorders first proposed the concept of the 'super-giant story'.

— 『On ■■』, unknown

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To Heimdal, the constellation, 'Guardian of the Great Water Bridge'—the universe of Asgard was a world perfect in terms of storytelling.

From childhood, he was fascinated by the movement of the stars. Stars occupying their own spots in the pitch-black void, repeating their orderly rotation and revolution.

Counting the magnificent stories interwoven among those stars, Heimdal dreamed that one day he, too, would become one of those great stars.

And Heimdal had the opportunity to become such a star.

「Ragnarok, the giant story of <Asgard> and the story of its great destruction.」

The nebula, which borrowed the probability of giant stories, had to reenact 'Ragnarok' at regular intervals to stabilize them.

[You shall be the sacrifice in this generation.]

A star that inherited the name of a great constellation for generations had an obligation to fulfill the role of that story.

Heimdal of this generation, too, lived solely for that duty.

To reenact the false yearning of 'Ragnarok' and to perform the ritual of sacrifice.

Through the sacrifice of him and a few companions, the World Tree of <Asgard> would bloom once again, and the 'giant story' would maintain its lineage.

Once, resentful of his plight, he even vented his frustrations to Odin, his 'one-eyed father'.

[Why did it have to be a dwarf?]

Odin asked back.

[Heimdall, do you feel wronged by being born with that name?]

[I do not want to die.]

[You are not the only one born with that fate. Thor and Tyr, whom you envy, are the same. Even in <Olympus> and <Vedas>, there are constellations that have received the same 'fate' as you.]

[What consolation is it that there is another victim besides me?]

[For a great story to continue, a star is needed to contain it. You have become the vessel of the story. Be proud.]

[What is there to be so proud of about being born as a vessel that will eventually break?]

[Heimdall, every being in the universe eventually dies.]

Odin spoke while gazing simultaneously at the night sky of the nine realms.

[Only our stars can leave their existence in the records.]

Heimdal could not understand the desires of the mythical constellations. Why did they want to be 'recorded' so desperately?

[So, what is the point? If we die anyway—]

Instead of answering Heimdal, Odin quietly spread his left hand. Then, a giant story began to tell its story within his hand.

Some stories silence all speech merely by existing there. Heimdal stopped even his incantations and became immersed in the story.

「It was the first 'Ragnarok'.」

The story that made the current <Asgard> possible. The story of uprooting the decaying universe and rebuilding a new world. The screams of constellations dying as they clash with the armies of hell. The spark of hope finally rising at the end of the pandemonium. Destruction and rebirth—as he savored that pure story, which could only be realized through story, Heimdal felt an inexplicable ecstasy. It was a feeling evoked only by constellations capable of understanding the story.

「This is how a star reaches eternity.」

For the first time, Heimdal felt a fierce greed.

「I want it.」

But since the story had already been written, he could not truly possess it. If he were to possess that story, there was only one way.

「I want to become a part of that story.」

A star that loves a story so deeply eventually becomes a part of it.

Just as is the fate of all stars, Heimdal accepted that destiny.

「I, the Guardian of the Great Bridge, have lived for this day.」

The story of the Nine Worlds took root in his hophus, intoxicated by ecstasy.

「End of Ragnarok.」

With the story heralding the end of the apocalypse, his mission came to an end. The myth concludes, and the world, having met its end, would finally be reborn.

Surely, it had to be.

[What, what on earth is this?]

Heimdal could not believe the scene unfolding before his eyes.

[I.]

The man who had endured the final story of <Asgard> stood before him.

Such a thing could not have happened. The 'King of Hell' who had faced this story should have surely perished along with him. But the 'King of Hell' did not die.

That meant only one fact.

「A story surpassing the great story 'Ragnarok' was dominating this scenario.」

But such a story could not possibly exist. There was no way a 'story' greater than the painful creation story of Asgard could exist—

[I want to stop reading you.]

The moment the man uttered that incantation, an anomaly occurred in the <Star Stream>. Whether it was an anomaly or some form that was impossible to even identify, the man's incantation quietly penetrated every star in the sky.

Following this, the sound of something tearing apart was heard from the high heavens. It was not merely the sound of 'space-time' collapsing.

「It was a sound that seemed to prove just how fragile the world they had lived in was.」

Just hearing it gave him a headache. His stomach churned. All his senses were fiercely warning him.

「You must not be here right now.」

As if receiving the same premonition, the other constellations were in a strange state as well. Some were scratching their bodies vigorously, while others looked around anxiously.

Constellations that met each other's eyes trembled violently.

「The sight of a terrified constellation was there.」

As one star let out a spine-chilling scream, the star next to it screamed as well.

「The stars shrieked like mere incarnations trapped in a subway car.」

The screams spread like a story. Some stars soared into the sky, while others sank into the earth.

But no matter where they moved, there was nowhere for them to escape. Because they were inside this 'story'—

「Now that 'story' was about to collapse.」

Heimdal saw the sky split open before his eyes. Some unknown, unprecedented force was tearing out the entire 'page' in which they existed.

He could not understand how such a thing was possible. Unable to overcome their terror, the stars finally spat out their stories.

「It cannot be written.」

The heads of the great-star constellations, unable to comprehend the scene before them, exploded. The stars, clinging to one another with nowhere to go, wailed.

「It cannot be read.」

No, it was not they who were wailing.

「HowcanIllivelikethisHowcanIllivelikethisHowcanIllivelikethisHowcanIllivelikethisHowcanIllivelikethisHowcanIllivelikethis」

Their stories were wailing.

「Idon'twanttobeerasedIdon'twanttobeerasedIdon'twanttobeerasedIdon'twanttobeerasedIdon'twanttobeerasedIdon'twanttobeerased」

The 'stage' was collapsing. The giant story of the great <Asgard> was being shattered.

Before he could even comprehend how such a thing was possible, Heimdal felt the world, including his incarnation body, being torn apart in its entirety.

[No—]

And those were the last words Heimdal left behind. The torn world was compressed whole and sucked into a small rift, and from within that rift, a sound like an inanimate object chewing and swallowing food could be heard. And then.

[The Star Stream restores the probability of this scenario!]

The world was sealed shut in an instant. The torn space and the rift vanished in a flash. As if nothing had happened, completely nonchalantly. Only the sparks of the reach raging violently in the void proved that an unbelievable miracle had just occurred in this world.

The recorders who had witnessed the scene from beginning to end amidst that spark were the first to regain their senses. Some, unable to overcome their terror, fell into a state of [recording interruption], while others, having attained a profound realization, leaped over the landscape.

Although no recorder grasped the true meaning of the scene, one courageous recorder nevertheless managed to record the outcome.

「And exactly half of the stars in the night sky vanished.」

As soon as that record was written, the stars' time, which had momentarily stopped, began to flow again.

[Ugh, ugh, aaaaaaah—!]

Unable to withstand the shock, the constellations let out vivid screams.

「The stars' 'stories' were torn apart in their entirety.」

Gasping for breath, the constellations shed tears of emotion as they sensed their remaining stories.

The joy of not yet being excluded from this world. The ecstasy of still remaining within this story. And the fear creeping in from the edge of that sense of relief.

「A death that leaves no record.」

The stars could not even remember the names of their vanished comrades. Only the deep, sinister void—the very presence of something—proved their absence.

Some mythical constellations, contextually recognizing the spot of that distant absence, hurriedly departed, but most of the constellations remaining here could not even muster the courage to flee.

Staring into the void, the stars went mad or fell into despair. They screamed in terror, and the stars' fear became a story. The bees willingly chose to be dominated by that story.

[Oldest One.]

Now, only easy submission remained for them.

[Oldest Dream!]

[I greet the Oldest Dream!]

Submission soon followed in a string like a testimony.

[A lowly star greets the 'Oldest Dream'!]

[Oooooo—!]

The sky of the <Star Stream> was lowering itself. It was paying homage to the star hanging in a position lower than any other.

[All the stars in this scenario gaze at a single Kim Dokja.]

Kim Dokja looked at those stars with indifferent eyes, then soon lowered his gaze.

There stood the incarnations who had luckily survived this scenario.

Kim Dokja smiled as he watched the incarnations bow their heads as if prostrating themselves.

「No incarnation dared to meet his eyes.」

Perhaps he had not used this power until now because he did not want to witness such a scene.

It was because he knew better than anyone that using this power would ruin the entire story.

A terrible loneliness ran down his spine. It was a feeling that only one person in this world could understand.

「No, maybe there was one more person.」

Where Kim Dokja slowly turned his gaze, there stood an incarnation that did not avoid his eyes. He was an incarnation that avoided no gaze whatsoever.

「There stood Kim Dokja's incarnation.」

He was a being born into this world by receiving the Holy Order of the 'Oldest Dream'.

"Kim Dokja."

As Yoo Joonghyuk called out the star's name, the star nodded in response.

The two faced each other for a moment. The night sky, with half the stars gone, twinkled ominously.

"That is as far as it goes."

Yoo Joonghyuk stood in front of Kim Dokja once again. Kim Dokja shook his head as Yoo Joonghyuk showed him the 'Black Heaven Demon Blade' held in his hand.

"You cannot stop me. You should know that clearly by now."

The power of the Oldest Dream.

Simply using it excludes every 'character' in this world from the story.

"I can stop you."

Kim Dokja smiled bitterly as he watched Yoo Joonghyuk, who still refused to yield.

"If I stop 'reading', then no matter who you are—"

"Try it."

"Yes?"

"Stop reading."

Yoo Joonghyuk continued to lash out as if he were ready at any moment.

"I know. Even if all the stars in the world stop 'reading'—"

The blade of the Black Heaven Demonic Blade was imbued with the chilling power of the Heaven-Shattering Qi.

"You, at least, cannot completely stop reading."

Kim Dokja's eyes wavered. Indeed, Yoo Joonghyuk's words pierced the very essence of the 'Oldest Dream'.

If this 'Universe' exists to be read, then the 'Oldest Dream' also exists to read.

And the protagonist, who had been read by the 'Oldest Dream' longer than anyone else, was right here.

"Very well. If you are so confident, go ahead and test it."

Kim Dokja spoke as he watched the protagonist finally reach the pinnacle of the <Star Stream>.

"Whether it will be sooner for me to 'stop reading' you, or for your sword to 'cut me'."

As if no further answer was needed, Yoo Joonghyuk's sword moved. The voices of Yoo Sangah and Lee Gilyoung, and the shout of Lee Jihye, could be heard.

The next moment, everything in the area was plunged into pitch-black darkness, just like a story that could no longer be read.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1028 Episode 63 Ragnarok (2)

I blinked my eyes again. Then, the record flashed before my eyes once more.

「And finally, another Kim Dokja opened his eyes in the darkness.」

It felt like I had had a short, terrible dream. The sensation of rising from a pile of pure white ashes. Fortunately, the condition of my incarnation was not bad.

Looking around, my situation came into view at a glance.

「I was still trapped inside the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's relic, the 'Yangjiokjeongbyeong'.」

I retraced my memories.

The fight to reclaim the third Kim Dokja. The Nameless Mist and the myth-grade constellations. The Great Sage Heaven's Equal, who chose to seal me to protect me, and me, trapped in his relic and being swept away.

And…

[The clone of the constellation, 'Oldest Liberator', is running out of strength.]

I saw a single strand of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal's hair, which I had been holding in my hand, scatter in a messy mess. It seemed as though my hair had lost its vitality from conveying memories.

「I glimpsed the memories of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' through the story of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal.」

Why Snowfield Kim Dokja started the scenario, and why I came to this world. I couldn't understand everything clearly, but I could at least confirm a vague outline.

Above all, the greatest gain was learning the past history between him and Cheon Inho.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja and Cheon Inho were much closer father and son than I had imagined. At least for a time.」

Looking at that scene, I thought. What if Snowfield Kim Dokja hadn't known the story of the outside world?

「What if he hadn't known about the 49% and 51% events?」

If that were the case, could he have lived peacefully with Cheon Inho forever within the snowfield?

[The story, 'Companion of the Snowfield' has been discovered.]

Companion of the Snowfield—this must be Cheon Inho's story. As I was examining that story for a moment, a message echoed in my head.

—No, what do you mean by waking up now? Do you know how long I spent waking you up?

It was the voice of the Demon King of Salvation.

I smiled awkwardly and asked back.

"How long did I sleep?"

—About a week.

My heart sank. It felt like I had only fallen asleep for a moment, but a whole week had already passed? The faces of the people I needed to look after belatedly flashed through my mind. What had become of Yoo Joonghyuk or Jung Heewon, who had escaped with me?

I hurriedly looked around inside the 'Yangjiokjeongbyeong' and saw the little clones of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal sprawled on the floor, having reverted back to hair. It certainly seemed that a lot of time had passed.

—There were a lot of guys looking for you.

I quickly checked the backlog of messages. The first one I checked was Yoo Joonghyuk's.

—Kim Dokja. ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ well ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ joined ■■■■■■.

It was a message sent via 'Midday Tryst'. Perhaps because I was wandering the outskirts of the scenario within the 'Yangjiokjeongbyeong', the message was not received properly.

Still, roughly interpreting it, it seems to mean that he is fine and will join soon.

Since Jung Heewon will be with Yoo Joonghyuk, there shouldn't be much need to worry.

In addition, I saw invitation messages sent by various constellations, including Dionysus.

[Some 'Constellation Factions' invite you!]

[Constellation Faction, 'Olympus', invites you.]

[Constellation Faction, 'Veda', invites you.]

…

Some nebulae had noticed that I was returning to the 'Ragnarok' scenario and had sent invitation messages to recruit me into their factions.

It wasn't strange. After all, the constellations had swarmed in to rush my recruitment even when I had just finished the preliminary battle.

「[That is, if you don't want to become like the other 'Kim Dokja'.]」

Suddenly, I remembered what Bakarine had said back then. Will the other Dokjas be okay? Even as I thought they would surely be fine, I couldn't shake off the strange anxiety that was welling up inside me.

What happened to Kim Anna?

I had given Kim Anna a separate ticket for the 'Disaster Side'. If my predictions were correct, Kim Anna would have become a key figure in the Disaster faction by now.

As I recalled my colleagues' faces one by one and checked the invitation messages, one message in particular caught my eye. It wasn't an 'invitation message' from a specific faction.

[Someone is calling you from the 'Archives'.]

Archives.

Hearing that name for the first time in a while brought many memories to my head.

Come to think of it, I hadn't used the 'Archives' much since becoming a 'Recorder of Fear'.

"When did this message arrive?"

—Three days ago.

Three days ago is already quite a bit of time. The person who sent the call from these 'Archives' must have already left. However, the 'Demon King of Salvation' seemed to have a slightly different idea.

—Still, wouldn't it be better to check? It might be a pretty good time to gather information at this point.

Come to think of it, I don't really know how the main stage of 'Ragnarok' is heading right now.

Judging by what the first one said, while I was staying in this 'Yangjiokjeongbyeong', the Kim Dokjas inside the [Fourth Wall] hadn't really heard or seen any other stories either.

[1 hour and 54 minutes remaining until re-entering the scenario area.]

Judging by the scenario message in the void, there is still some time left before re-entering 'Ragnarok'.

"Then I'll be right back."

Whether the caller from the archives was still there or not, it was well worth the visit. Even if I couldn't meet the caller, I could still get information from other recorders.

—Right. Call us if anything happens.

Although he said that, the Demon King of Salvation didn't seem particularly worried. After all, at this point, beings that could pose a threat to me are extremely rare.

A faint noise could be heard from inside the [Fourth Wall], as if the Kim Dokjas were holding a strategy meeting among themselves. Since they were about to enter the final scenario, it seemed there was much to discuss.

"I accept the invitation from the Archives."

[You agree to the call from the 'Archives'.]

As soon as I answered, the surrounding scenery changed, and I felt my soul connecting to somewhere.

It had been a long time since I had entered Bicheonhori's Archives.

Who could have summoned me?

It could be Bicheonhori himself, or it could be Asmodeus.

Or it could be the 'Unchanging One' whom I had taken in as a subordinate recorder. Or perhaps it was 'Moraleok' whom I had encountered at the Archives sometime ago.

It could have been a trap, or a message requesting cooperation.

In truth, I felt that it didn't matter which it was. I don't know why, but that was the case. Perhaps it was the confidence gained from gathering three Kim Dokjas.

「After gathering three Kim Dokjas, something inside me changed.」

That was the only explanation I could offer at the moment.

From the moment the Demon King of Salvation, the Great King of Fear, and the Prisoner of the Golden Cage entered my [Fourth Wall], I became something different.

[You have entered the 'Archives'!]

The 'Archives', which I had entered for the first time in a long while, was quite different from the scenery I remembered.

The 'rooms' where recorders used to gather to revise [Fate] were nowhere to be seen.

Instead, what unfolded before my eyes was a massive library.

「A library that gives me a strange sense of déjà vu, as if I have seen it somewhere before.」

I slowly approached the bookshelf and pulled out a book. As soon as I opened it, someone's dialogue burst out.

「(If the 'scenarios' hadn't started, what would have happened to us?)」

I paused and silently followed along with the dialogue.

「(Would we still be working at the same company?)」

I knew exactly whose dialogue it was and in which passage it appeared. Examining the book's cover, I saw the title I had expected.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint Chapter 371_3rd Proofreading』

Main Story Chapter 371.

This passage depicted the scene where Yoo Sangah, on the verge of reincarnation, shared her final conversation with Kim Dokja inside the [Fourth Wall].

Perhaps it was because it had been a long time since I had read a manuscript.

I kept turning the pages as if under a spell.

「(I must have always wondered about you, Dokja-ssi. Are you doing well? Are you sick anywhere?)」

Yoo Sangah asked, and Kim Dokja answered. The two talked in a space strictly for the two of them.

「(See? I told you they would definitely have become close.)」

「'…Did they?'」

They talked about impossible dreams, and about a future that might have been possible in another universe.

「(Of course. Studying Spanish together, joining the cycling club and riding bikes together.)」

My heart ached the entire time I was reading that conversation.

「'We might have lived near each other.'」

For every reader, 're-reading' meant facing one's past self.

Although I was clearly reading the story of Kim Dokja and Yoo Sangah right now—

「(Of course. Maybe we lived right next door.)」

At the same time, I was thinking of the me who wrote that story long ago—the person who used to read the story I had worked so hard to write.

「I, too, had someone like Yoo Sangah.」

At that moment, a single white finger appeared over the proofs.

"Ah, a parenthesis is missing here. Argh, I checked it so carefully!"

The moment I heard her voice, I turned to look beside me in delight. Standing there was the person I had longed for for so long.

"Editor-nim!"

It was Ji Eunyu.

"I should be called 'Cloud Mountain' here."

The moment I saw Ji Eunyu reply so nonchalantly, I could not suppress my joy. Only then did I realize who had summoned me to these 'Archives'.

"Surely not Editor-nim—"

"That's right. I called you. You were arriving so late that I was thinking of leaving, but here we are. I'm glad I waited."

To my surprise, Ji Eunyu did not look like Min Jiwon. She looked exactly like the 'Ji Eunyu' I remembered from long ago.

Short bob hair. The white cotton T-shirt and long jeans she usually wore.

With her hands clasped behind her back, Ji Eunyu turned toward the bookshelf and spoke.

"This is my 'archive'."

Ji Eunyu's archive?

"I learned how to make one from Bicheonhori."

Was it possible to apply that in this way? I followed her, marveling anew.

"Then all the manuscripts here are..."

"They are manuscripts you know well, too, Author-nim."

The manuscripts occupying this bookshelf were all countless proofs of 「Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint」.

From the first draft to the fourth. Live serialization version and the second version, paperback version and hardcover version…

In one corner, a bookshelf containing only discarded manuscripts was also visible.

「This library was the 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' that Ji Eunyu remembers.」

Hiding the emotions welling up inside me, I approached Ji Eunyu.

Ji Eunyu had taken a book from the bookshelf and was reading it.

"It was really tough back then. Do you remember?"

I nodded as I read the passage Ji Eunyu pointed to. It happened to be the part where Kim Dokja dies.

"Ah, that's right. I suddenly got sick and was hospitalized while writing this part..."

"You remember! You know how hard it was for me to take care of you back then."

"You mean the time you came all the way to the hospital to pressure me for the deadline?"

Ji Eunyu continued to chatter away, with the face I knew so well.

"Do you remember this part? You cried after writing this, didn't you? Saying you felt like you wrote it completely wrong."

Once again, it was the part where Kim Dokja dies. Thinking to myself, "Have I killed this guy off too often?" I replied.

"I never cried."

"Wow, you're denying it now."

We giggled as we shared stories not written in the manuscript. It didn't feel real. That all that time had passed. That the stories we had written and revised had become dozens of books.

「The history of our lives was there.」

After finishing one volume, we walked to another bookshelf. Was rereading a story with a written ending always this enjoyable? I wanted to read other scenes together right away. I wanted to chat. Before all these stories vanished. I wanted to talk a little more while this blank space allowed us.

But.

"Author-nim."

The moment I saw Ji Eunyu stop abruptly, I realized that this joy had come to an end.

"So much has happened, hasn't it?"

Before I could even fully nod, Ji Eunyu stood on tiptoe, pulled a book from the shelf, and handed it to me. I thought it might be the part where Kim Dokja dies again, but the title of the book seemed a bit strange.

『Killer King— Cha Seongwoo』

I stared down at the book for a long time, unable to say a word. For some reason, the hand holding the book was trembling.

「This was not the story of Kim Dokja that I had written.」

It felt as though if I opened this book and read it, everything would become irreversible.

When I looked up, Ji Eunyu was looking at me.

"I'm sorry, Author-nim."

I couldn't ask what she was sorry for. Perhaps I didn't want to know. I didn't want to open this book. Even so.

「I must confirm the death of Kim Dokja that I did not write.」

I opened the book.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1029 Episode 63 Ragnarok (3)

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I began reading the story of Killer King—Cha Seongwoo. I read it sentence by sentence, like someone trying to swallow every single sentence contained in the book without missing a single one.

「Cha Seongwoo read that story over and over again for a very long time.」

The Cha Seongwoo inside the book was reading a story I knew well.

「"Okay, this is the 30th one."」

What kind of expression did Kim Dokja make when reading a sad story? Since he was the kind of guy who liked sad stories the most, did he read even that with a smile?

「"Now the 50th one."」

As I read his story, I didn't know what expression to make. Even though I knew that if I finished reading this story, I would become the most miserable person in the world, I simply couldn't stop reading.

Just as I read him, the Cha Seongwoo inside the book also read the novel.

Returning to previous pages again and again like a time traveler in front of scenes he liked. Or adding footnotes as he pleased.

「"Hmm, so this is what it meant."」

A person's reading contains their worldview. Just by knowing what kind of stories they like, we can learn a great deal about them.

In that sense, Cha Seongwoo was a very meticulous person. He did not simply gloss over stories just because he already knew them. The more familiar a scene was, and the more times he had read it, the more diligently and slowly he read it.

Just like Kim Dokja who read 'Ways of Survival'.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Watching Cha Seongwoo unconsciously repeat his favorite lines over and over, and seeing his page-turning speed slow down the more he read, I, too, was afraid to turn the page.

「"Is this finally the 99th one?"」

I was afraid to see the end of the story. But just as Cha Seongwoo did in the story, I, too, read his story. I had to read it.

「"I finished reading."」

Solely reading. Reading with all one's might and recreating the story in one's mind. Because that is the job of a reader.

"Ah."

Finally, with the 99th reading, Cha Seongwoo's reading came to an end. And that was the entirety of the story of Cha Seongwoo that now rested in my hands.

This single book was a record of Cha Seongwoo reading the story he loved from beginning to end.

Tsutsu.

The moment I closed the book, stories settled into my fingertips with a faint spark. An infinitely warm, persistent, and cozy sensation.

"This."

The moment my hand touched stories, a scene unfolded in my mind.

Cha Seongwoo collapsing, and 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' gazing at his soul.

I got goosebumps.

「Snowfield will absorb Cha Seongwoo.」

'Snowfield Kim Dokja' is a being who lives to become 'the one and only Kim Dokja.'

For the sake of his own purpose, he would never simply abandon the soul of Cha Seongwoo, who was dying before his very eyes.

「"No, this is not where you belong. Because you..."」

However, Snowfield within the landscape let Cha Seongwoo go with those words.

「"It wasn't me, but my 'comrade', wasn't it?"」

While restarting the scenario and retracing all the history that Kim Dokja had lived through, Cha Seongwoo was always by Snowfield's side.

「To Snowfield, Cha Seongwoo was truly a 'comrade'.」

Cha Seongwoo cleared the scenarios together with him and fought against the constellations.

Perhaps that is why Snowfield could never fully absorb Cha Seongwoo as 'Kim Dokja'. Because the Cha Seongwoo he remembered—perhaps not the image of the 'Kim Dokja' he wanted to unite into one.

I was somewhat surprised by Snowfield's human side, yet at the same time, I felt pity.

「Before my eyes stood the soul of Cha Seongwoo, in the form of a young Kim Dokja.」

Only after confirming the entire landscape did I understand how Cha Seongwoo's soul had come to this place.

Perhaps Ji Eunyu led Cha Seongwoo’s soul to her 'archive' and delivered it to me here.

As I placed my hand upon Cha Seongwoo’s soul, which took the form of a small baby, it felt as though I could hear his voice.

「"Kim Dokja."」

Even though it is the same name, the temperature of the voice can be so different depending on who calls it.

I thought of the man who loved this story more than anyone, the man who had read the single story a hundred times. Then, I felt the man's soul slowly seeping into me.

[Exclusive Skill, 'Fourth Wall', activated!]

Cha Seongwoo's soul flowed into the wall in an instant.

[A massive amount of 'Loss' has been collected.]

[The 'Loss' you collected will be recorded on the Final Wall.]

With that, I felt as though something very important within me had been completed.

As if knowing it would eventually turn out this way, the story within me began to stir.

[The story, 'Heir to the Eternal Name', gazes at you.]

Kyung Sein, Dansu ahjussi, Cha Seongwoo—in the end, I made it this far while losing all my comrades.

Will I truly be able to say that I am a 'Kim Dokja' better than any other 'Kim Dokja' at the end of this world?

"Editor-nim."

I called out to Ji Eunyu. There were many things I wanted to ask. But above all, there was something I had to ask first. It was because of the scenery I had seen earlier.

The final encounter between Cha Seongwoo and 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

It was a fleeting scene, but I clearly saw the people standing in the background of that landscape.

「Yoo Joonghyuk and <Kim Dokja Company> were definitely there.」

My heart pounded.

"Did you happen to meet <Kim Dokja Company>?"

Ji Eunyu slowly nodded.

"Yes, I met them."

The moment I saw her expression, a flood of mixed emotions washed over me.

「Finally, <Kim Dokja Company> has descended upon the 41st round.」

But at the same time, a question arose. Why did they, who had remained silent all this time, have to choose to come here of all places?

"Because I summoned them."

A belated sigh escaped my lips.

Ji Eunyu continued speaking.

"Summoning them was the last resort I had in mind. Snowfield Kim Dokja had become too strong, and I felt that borrowing the power of any other group wouldn't be able to stop him."

I nodded. Snowfield Kim Dokja must have obtained just as many 'Kim Dokja Fragments' as I do now. Moreover, having lived as 'Kim Dokja' for much longer than I have, his 'dream control' must be at an unimaginable level.

"I thought they would be able to stop him."

Ji Eunyu's judgment was not wrong.

In fact, the <Kim Dokja Company> of the 1,864th round was the strongest force across the <Star Stream> of all worldlines. Even for 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', it wouldn't have been easy to face that <Kim Dokja Company>.

"It was a gamble that could only be attempted right before the conclusion."

I nodded in agreement.

Unlike in the 'Missing Thicket', the probability of <Kim Dokja Company>'s arrival would have been resolved to some extent in 'Ragnarok'.

However, there was one thing that bothered me.

Snowfield Kim Dokja had attempted to summon <Kim Dokja Company> using his fragment in the world where the 'Third Kim Dokja' existed, and had tried to recreate the 'Big House' in that world.

That plan failed because of me and Yoo Joonghyuk, but the words left by the fragment of Snowfield at the very last moment still lingered in my mind.

「"My main body knew that <Kim Dokja Company> would not come here."」

"So, what happened?"

I had a strangely ominous premonition.

What if all of this was part of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja's' plan? What if his real plan from the very beginning was to bring <Kim Dokja Company> down to 'Ragnarok'?

Trying to suppress the anxiety swirling in my head, I recalled the <Kim Dokja Company> I knew. I thought of Yoo Joonghyuk, stronger than anyone in this world, and the wise Yoo Sangah. I thought of Lee Jihye, unrivaled at sea; Lee Gilyoung, the contractor of the Demon God; and Lee Seolhwa, who always revives every comrade.

Surely, they would have safely subdued 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'. If even they couldn't do it, it was a task no one else could have accomplished.

Ji Eunyu still did not answer.

"Editor-nim?"

I wonder when it started. Ji Eunyu's presence had faded slightly. In that instant, I realized something.

「I'm sorry, Author-nim. <Kim Dokja Company> is…」

I grabbed Ji Eunyu's wrist.

"Editor-nim."

My mind was spinning.

「Why did Ji Eunyu have to wait for me here for three days?」

"You don't have to say anything. Don't say any more."

I could see the wrist I was holding gradually fading. Her soul, story, was disappearing.

「No matter who Ji Eunyu is, there is no way she could have summoned <Kim Dokja Company> without any price.」

I wanted to erase the record being written in my mind. I didn't want to admit that fact.

I held onto Ji Eunyu, injecting stories with all my might. Ji Eunyu looked at me quietly, then smiled faintly.

"I'm fine, Author-nim. This story has reincarnation and resurrection, you know."

"…"

"Every time Kim Dokja kept dying, I wondered if it was okay, but now I'm glad this is that kind of story."

"Editor-nim."

I knew what Ji Eunyu was trying to say. Perhaps that is how many stories we had shared. Or perhaps I thought we had shared them.

However, despite having shared so much, I felt that I still knew absolutely nothing about the person named Ji Eunyu.

"You said it, didn't you? That you didn't write this story. That you merely transcribed what Han Sooyoung wrote."

The sensation in the wrist I was holding gradually faded. Ji Eunyu continued speaking.

"I don't think so. Even if that were true, you are the one who wrote this story to me. So, Author-nim."

I wanted to say anything to her as she disappeared. But once again, I couldn't find the right words. That is why the one who filled the last blank space given to me was always the person who read this story for the first time.

"I hope Kim Dokja survives this time, too."

Ji Eunyu's figure scattered like magic. Following her, the books she had collected began to vanish. The 'Archives' were disappearing. The records she had gathered, all of time, were vanishing and scattering away.

I couldn't believe it. It was none other than Ji Eunyu. The person who understood this story just as well as I did.

"Editor-nim."

I called out to her in vain.

"Ji Eunyu-ssi!"

I called again. No answer came back. Only then did the reality of what had happened begin to sink in.

「I must now complete the story without her.」

With the sensation of the connection being severed, I found myself back in the 'Yangjiokjeongbyeong' before I knew it.

「Unlike Cha Seongwoo, Ji Eunyu's soul did not dwell within me.」

I did not know whether to rejoice or grieve at that fact. Where had Ji Eunyu's soul gone? Was she really dead?

<Kim Dokja Company> truly, to 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'...

[Entering the scenario area soon.]

[The 'Scenario Grade' of this scenario area has been upgraded.]

[The <Star Stream> evaluates your 'Rank'.]

With my mind in turmoil, a scenario message appeared before my eyes.

[You possess sufficient 'Rank' to enter this scenario.]

[Entering Main Scenario #98 — 'Ragnarok'.]

In the end, to uncover the whole truth, I must return to the scenario once again.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1030 Episode 63. Ragnarok (4)

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[You have re-entered the Main Scenario!]

With a slight dizziness, I arrived in the scenario area, and a desolate land unfolded before my eyes.

「Is this really the main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'?」

I wondered if something had gone wrong and looked around several times. But no matter how much I looked, the only thing that caught my eye was the 'Yangji Jade Vase' I had ridden here.

[The star relic 'Yangji Jade Vase' has completed its task.]

The 'Yangji Jade Vase' shrank again after spitting me out. I picked up the star relic of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal and strapped it to my waist. I wondered if I would have a chance to return it someday. I hoped so.

Tsssss.

It was then that a light spark ran through my body.

[The 'Loss' that your incarnation body can acquire is close to its limit!]

It was a message I had never seen before in my life. The limit of acquired 'Loss'. Did it mean I could no longer absorb 'Kim Dokja fragments'?

Frowning slightly, I stared into the air, wondering what it was, when a welcome message arrived.

[The story 'Successor of the Eternal Name' makes a displeased expression.]

Thinking that maybe this guy would know the answer, I readily spoke to it.

"Hey, do you know what that means?"

[The story 'Successor of the Eternal Name' pouts.]

I guess it didn't want to answer. I asked another question.

"Is there anything else you feel? Do you know where this is?"

Actually, it was strange. If this place was really the 'main battlefield' of 'Ragnarok', and if 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was here, the Successor would have definitely reacted strongly. But it didn't show any particular reaction. Fluttering for a moment as if thinking, it sent a message.

[The story 'Successor of the Eternal Name' tells you to keep walking forward for now.]

Since it didn't seem like it would give me advice that would harm me in the current situation, I followed its advice and started walking.

Walking through the quiet ruins covered in sparse gray fog, I thought of the people I liked and the people who might be waiting for me. And I thought of my readers who would be reading this story beyond [The Fourth Wall].

Now the end of the story was approaching.

[The exclusive skill 'The Fourth Wall' shakes faintly.]

Would I be able to write the conclusion of this world safely on my own? And could that conclusion really be the ■■ that all Kim Dokjas wanted? As if in response to my question, the 'Yangji Jade Vase' at my waist trembled.

I stopped in my tracks after walking for a while because of a sign visible in the distance. A strange sense of déjà vu crossed my mind.

「There was a ticket booth there.」

Memories came back one after another. I had already been here once with Jung Heewon. This ticket booth... there was no doubt about it.

「The ticket booth for the 'Preliminary Battle'.」

As I approached the ticket booth, I saw corpses scattered in the fog. From lower-grade warriors to upper-grade warriors. The bodies of warriors who died, regardless of whether they were incarnations or constellations, were there. Even the ticket booth clerk was dead. It was the very clerk who had used [Cool-headed Observation] on me and rated me as a 'lower-intermediate warrior'.

「"A war. You guys don't really know what 'Ragnarok' is."」

The words he left me were still clear in my ears.

「"If you really start something like that, everyone dies. Well, even if it doesn't start, unlucky guys will die anyway."」

The moment I checked his lifeless eyes, I knew. Perhaps in this scenario, 'the thing where everyone dies if it starts' had happened.

Behind the ticket booth, the ruins of the broken colosseum—'Valhalla Hall'—were visible.

[Your story reacts to the stage!]

The events that had occurred in Valhalla Hall flashed quickly through my head. Meeting Anna Croft with Jung Heewon. Winning the Preliminary Battle, and meeting Mitra and the gang from the 'Golden Dice Hall' also came to mind.

「[Thank you, successor.]」

The face of Samyeongdaesa, who sacrificed himself on behalf of my companions and me at the last moment, also came to mind.

Come to think of it, what happened to the 'super-large battlefield' after I left? My companions and I had escaped the battlefield through the 'Bush of the Missing', but the other participants...

[A new sub scenario has arrived!]

It was then that a message arrived.

[You are a 'Returnee'.]

[Currently, a suitable sub scenario has been allocated to you.]

Returnee Scenario. It seemed that the scenario system of the <Star Stream>, which had been suspended for a while, had regained its function.

Let's see. Originally, a 'Returnee Scenario' should be 'Returning Home in Glory'...

**[Main Scenario #45 - Return (還鄕)]**

Category: Main

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: You are a 'Returnee' who has returned to the scenario ahead of the worst destruction. Enter the 'Hall'. Then join one of the King's forces to prepare for the upcoming destruction of the <Star Stream>. The end of this world is already determined. Do not try to learn the truth. Do not hold any hope.

Time Limit: 24 hours

Reward: -

Failure: Death

* There is an associated 'Hidden Scenario' for this scenario.

The contents of the scenario were simple. Join one of the King's forces. What was ominous was the message written after it.

「The end of this world is already determined. Do not try to learn the truth. Do not hold any hope.」

No scenario had ever used such expressions in its 'clear conditions'. After all, there was no need to write phrases that crushed the incarnations' hopes before they even started. All scenarios were harsh anyway, and the Administration Bureau had an obligation to encourage the incarnations as much as possible to create 'interesting stories'.

Therefore, the dokkaebis, who knew very well that the constellations were more crazy about stories created by incarnations eager for hope, would not write such a buzzkill phrase from the beginning...

The moment my thoughts reached there, a terrible imagination crossed my mind.

What if there weren't many 'constellations' left in the <Star Stream> to enjoy the stories of those incarnations? What if even the storytellers had given up on the conclusion of this story?

I struggled to maintain my composure and continued to check the additional information of the scenario.

* Currently, there are a total of four Kings in the 'Hall'.

* The King of the East.

* The King of the West.

* The King of the South.

* The King of the North.

That was the end of the information.

Perhaps there was one 'King' for each region of 'East, West, South, and North'. It was confusing. Why on earth did something like a 'King' appear in Valhalla Hall?

Right after the last 'super-large battlefield' I participated in opened, all the constellations of 'Valhalla Hall' were dragged to the 'Preliminary Battle' or went straight to the 'Main Battlefield'. But the existence of a 'King' meant that there was also a group following him. Could it be that there were still constellations who hadn't entered the 'Main Battlefield'?

[Do you want to enter the 'Hall'?]

I hesitated for a moment, then stepped toward the entrance of the Hall. There was no way to verify the situation without seeing it with my own eyes first.

[You have entered the 'Hall'!]

As soon as I entered, a familiar landscape appeared. A vast prairie. Except for a strange burnt smell brushing the tip of my nose, this was the 'battlefield' I knew.

「Super-large battlefield.」

There was no doubt about it. The exact same scenery as the 'super-large battlefield' I had participated in. What could it be? Had the inside of 'Valhalla Hall' completely vanished, leaving only the stage of this 'super-large battlefield'?

[Currently, the 'Hall' is fused with the 'Super-large Battlefield'.]

[You can plot the end together with the surviving stars here.]

I smiled bitterly. There were no signs of life nearby to call them surviving stars.

[The story 'Slayer Beyond Records' begins its narration.]

Was it because I had entered a familiar stage? The story I obtained by clearing the 'Preliminary Battle' squirmed inside me. At the same time, the silent Successor also reacted.

[The story 'Successor of the Eternal Name' guides you.]

It seemed the Successor had found the way to the main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'.

I continued to move in the direction guided by the Successor. Incarnation bodies of dead constellations were visible here and there. Some were constellations I knew well.

[Story fragments of the constellation 'God of Peace and Relief' are drifting nearby.]

[Story fragments of the constellation 'Nurturer of Light and Compassion' are drifting nearby.]

The 'God of Peace and Relief' was a constellation struggling with gambling debts, and the 'Nurturer of Light and Compassion' was a constellation that took over incarnations from such debtors and trafficked them. Even those guys ended up caught in the 'super-large battlefield' and lost their lives.

In certain areas, giant scorch marks remained. It looked like the place where a 'sanctuary' capable of mass transporting to the 'main battlefield' had occurred.

Did <Emperor>'s sun hunter 'Yi' safely enter the 'main battlefield'? What happened to Mitra and the remnants of the 'Golden Dice Hall'?

Thinking of Mitra, who had asked me to call his name at the round table, I kept walking. How long did I walk? I finally arrived at the target location.

「In the center of the lonely prairie, there was a giant 'gate'.」

A gate of truly enormous size, looking as if even the true body of a myth-grade constellation like 'Mitra' could pass through it. The gate was wrapped tightly in giant chains as if sealed by someone. Surprisingly, each chain was made of 'story metal'.

That wasn't all. At the entrance of the gate, talismans written in an unknown otherworldly language were attached, and even the giant 'bar' inserted to seal the entrance of the gate was the star relic of a constellation I knew well.

The Ruyi Jingu Bang.

I got goosebumps. Who on earth sealed the entrance to this gate? The desperate traces of sealing the gate seemed to prove how desperate the sealers were.

「As if there was something beyond here that must absolutely never cross over.」

Approaching near the gate, I felt the stories inside me react.

[The story 'Successor of the Eternal Name' growls.]

Even with such a thick gate in between, there was a vivid despair felt from beyond.

「My brother is beyond this gate.」

[This entrance connects to the 'Main Battlefield'.]

[Warning! You cannot open the entrance!]

[If you want to open the entrance, defeat the 'Kings' of the battlefield and acquire the 'Key' to open the entrance!]

I let out a light sigh.

"I'm sorry, but..."

I didn't have the luxury of humoring the scenario's tantrums right now.

"I'm not in the mood for games."

I had to go to the 'main battlefield' right now. What happened to Ji Eunyu, how many surviving readers were there, what happened to <Kim Dokja's Company>. What my last brother had become. I had to find out everything.

mathbf{Force it open.}

「Force it open.」

I opened my stories. And I put my hand on the giant chain surrounding the gate.

Kudududuk.

Harsh sparks began to strike the area, and a strong warning rang in my ears. But I ignored all of them and kept injecting my stories.

Eventually, the chain, which seemed like it would never break, began to crack, and the sound of it snapping resounded. I succeeded in breaking the first chain solely with the power of my story.

[Part of the 'Gate's' seal has been released!]

A wild wind of massive sparks blew from the sky. And a true voice was heard from somewhere.

[That guy! What is that guy!]

[He's trying to open the gate!]

[Report to the King! We must report to the King!]

Were there still beings alive in this 'super-large battlefield'? A group of constellations came riding weirdly-shaped bikes in the distance, staring this way. The guys who sped across the desolate prairie were all wearing something like monkey masks on their heads.

[The constellation 'A Certain Monkey of the Water Curtain Cave' looks at you!]

[The constellation '500-Year-Old [Filtered]' looks at you!]

It seemed they were all broken somewhere, as their modifiers were abnormal. Thinking it was actually a good thing, I stopped injecting stories and called them.

"Hey."

When I spoke to them, the monkey masks shrank back in surprise.

[D-Don't go near! Don't go near him!]

Perhaps it was natural. From the moment I unleashed the power of my stories, ordinary constellations had no choice but to be crushed by the pressure.

[The story 'Slayer Beyond Records' continues its narration!]

Perhaps because I was using a semi-myth-grade story that fit this stage, the monkey masks screamed as if they were almost suffocating.

[Hyaaaaaaaah!]

Just by witnessing me, the afterimages of the stars I had killed were visible in their eyes.

[T-The one who killed the bird!]

[Monkey! Monkey slayer!]

During the Preliminary Battle, I had defeated many of <Vedas>' constellations, including 'The Bird Who Eats Thunder' and 'General of Banara'. Perhaps they were glimpsing that history now.

It was then that a sound like beating drums was heard from the distant sky.

[The King's... story!]

At the same time, the constellations wearing monkey masks all looked up at the sky. And I saw an unbelievable sight.

Giant wings covering the sky. A bird scattering pitch-black feathers was descending toward this place.

「The bird I killed, the 'Bird Who Eats Thunder'—one of the Eight Legions, 'Garuda' was there.」

No, looking closely, it wasn't 'Garuda' flying toward us, but 'Garuda's shadow'. Someone was flying while riding Garuda's shadow.

Kwakwakwakwa!

Lightning struck from the air. A lightning strike so immense that I momentarily wondered if Zeus or Odin had descended poured down on me.

I immediately activated my story.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its narration.]

The 'Demon King of Salvation' mode, which I could now use easily at any time. I activated [Character Transformation] and easily dodged or brushed away the pouring lightning.

Shortly after, Garuda's shadow landed amidst the thick dust. The moment the dust cleared as the wind blew, I was able to confirm the true identity of the star who had thrown lightning at me.

When I first saw him, I thought Hanuman, the 'General of Banara' whom I had killed, had been resurrected. But looking closer, he was merely wearing Hanuman's hide.

After observing me for a long time, he asked.

[You... what on earth are you?]

For an instant, a corner of my chest seemed to creak.

[The story 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' is sorrowful.]

The story embedded in one side of my heart throbbed. I could know instinctively. The being in front of me now was one of the 'Kings' of this ruin.

「A constellation whom I thought I would never be able to see again in this life was standing there.」

Only now did everything seem to make sense. Why my brother—'The Oldest Liberator' had sent me here riding the 'Yangji Jade Vase'. Why I had to arrive at this ruin first instead of the 'main battlefield'.

With burning eyes, he asked.

[How do you have my star relic?]

Now in front of my eyes stood the 'Great Sage Heaven's Equal' of the 41st round.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1031 Episode 63. Ragnarok (5)

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The Handsome Monkey King was not in a good mood today. There were many reasons for his bad mood, and to be more precise, it wasn't just today that he was in a bad mood.

[NOTE 1]

For a constellation of the Handsome Monkey King's level, it was possible to read the heavenly secret of the <Star Stream>. Though it was called a heavenly secret, to put it simply, it felt like this:

「Predicting what will happen in the future through the positions of the constellations.」

Reading the heavenly secret was similar to analyzing the stock market for humans.

「Watching the movements of each faction, institution, and foreigner, observing their positions, and finding out what will happen to the market in the future.」

For reference, the market trend of the <Star Stream> today that he had read was as follows:

[Did everyone really die?]

Of course, the stars in the sky weren't actually all delisted. Nevertheless, the stars were clearly declining. The light of the once-powerful 'giant nebulas' was going out, and the

stars that had looked down on the world from the top of the sky suddenly vanished or fell.

[Are you really going to give up like this! Where did all those myth-grade constellations who used to show off so much go!]

There is nothing more helpless than waiting for the end in a world that might perish at any moment. The Handsome Monkey King stood up abruptly, swallowing his anger.

[If we're going to die anyway, we should at least struggle!]

Currently, he was one of the four 'Kings' ruling this 'Hall'. Specifically, he was called the 'Monkey King' of the North.

[U-Uaaah!]

[My King!]

Whenever he passed by, the foolish constellations wearing monkey masks shouted.

[The constellation 'A Certain Monkey of the Water Curtain Cave' prays to you!]

Because they had witnessed the great catastrophe of 'Ragnarok' with their own eyes, their minds had collapsed and their stories had shattered, leaving them unable to live without relying on the stories of other stars.

The Handsome Monkey King patted the shoulders of those stars lightly, then glared at the sky and said:

[If worst comes to worst, I want to invade even if I'm alone, but...]

The Handsome Monkey King also didn't fail to understand the feelings of the stars that fled from the end. Beyond the 'gate' that this Hall sealed, there were indeed such monsters teeming. The Handsome Monkey King had also clearly seen what monsters were on the main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'. Even his brothers were all killed by those monsters.

Great Sage Heaven's Equal.

Bimawen.

Victorious Fighting Buddha.

He and his brothers had all participated in 'Ragnarok'. His brothers' plan was simple. They planned to take advantage of the chaos in the heavenly realm to steal core stories from <Emperor>'s Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors, thereby leaping to become 'myth-grade constellations'.

The plan proceeded sequentially, and a myth-grade constellation was just around the corner. That was, until the 'great catastrophe' of 'Ragnarok' suddenly opened its eyes.

「At a single word from the great catastrophe, half of the stars in the night sky fell.」

Among the shattered half were his brothers. Fortunately, his brothers had transferred all of their stories to him right before their dissipation, but in return, their souls disappeared from the <Star Stream>.

[Your incomplete story finishes its narration.]

Fortunately, the Handsome Monkey King was in an area far from the catastrophe, so he was able to avoid the dissipation of his incarnation body. But his other brothers were not so lucky. Clenching the stories of his brothers lodged inside him, the Handsome Monkey King bit his lips tightly.

His brothers were all detestable fellows. But no matter how detestable they were, brothers were brothers. He had not ruled out the thought of revenge either.

「"Handsome Monkey King. You must survive."」

The one who stopped him was the incarnation he cherished. The incarnation of the Korean Peninsula, Min Jiwon. Using the 'Pluck of Request' that the Handsome Monkey King had given her once, she banished his incarnation body from the 'main battlefield'.

「"Please, survive somehow—"」

To survive and plot for the future. That was her last message.

[The contract of the 'Pluck of Request' is activated!]

[You have been banished from the 'Main Battlefield'!]

[You cannot participate in the 'Main Battlefield' for the next two months!]

Since then, he had tried contacting her several times, but no news returned.

「Tomorrow, the restriction on participating in the 'main battlefield' forced upon him by the 'Pluck of Request' would end.」

By tomorrow, it would be two months since the Handsome Monkey King came to this 'Hall'. During those two months, he recovered his strength and prepared to return to the 'main battlefield'.

The problem was that in order to return to the 'main battlefield', he needed the cooperation of the other Kings.

「Two months ago, the Handsome Monkey King, along with the other Kings, had sealed the gate leading to the 'main battlefield'.」

Because of this issue, the Handsome Monkey King had gone to see the other Kings several times. Saying that his strength was fully recovered, so let's go up to the battlefield once more and fight against the catastrophe. But none of the other three Kings had any intention of opening that 'gate' again.

[Cowards.]

Only then did the Handsome Monkey King think that perhaps his ■■ ended here. His long-cherished wish to rise to the myth-grade and take revenge on the heavenly realm had gone awry, and the giant nebulas he hated had fallen.

[Is it really up to here.]

Had he ever seen such a dark sky in the <Star Stream> before? Looking at the sky of the <Star Stream> which had now lost even its day, the Handsome Monkey King remembered his brothers.

「It was then that a new star rose in the sky.」

Startled, the Handsome Monkey King glared at the sky with wide eyes. A star he had never seen before, yet its bright light gave him a sense of déjà vu. At the same time, the Handsome Monkey King sensed an unusual current pervading the battlefield.

The shaking ground. The sound of chains breaking.

「Someone is trying to open the 'gate'.」

The moment I saw the constellation in front of me, sharp memories rushed in. The image of my big brother, who threw away everything to save me, was vivid in my eyes.

"You are..."

After taking a breath, the memories receded like the tide, and the being in front of me was clearly visible.

"You are not the Great Sage Heaven's Equal."

It was a subtle difference, but I could tell. The 'Monkey King' in front of me was not the Great Sage Heaven's Equal. He was his brother, who possessed the Great Sage's story.

"Are you... the Handsome Monkey King?"

At my call, the Handsome Monkey King's lips twitched.

[I asked. How did you get my star relic—]

"This vase is not from this world."

Instead of a detailed explanation, I threw the star relic 'Yangji Jade Vase' to him. Receiving the star relic in a daze, he opened his eyes wide and began to examine the 'Yangji Jade Vase'.

I looked at the Handsome Monkey King and asked:

"Are your other brothers here by any chance?"

The Handsome Monkey King's presence here meant that his other brothers must have also participated in 'Ragnarok'. But his answer completely betrayed my expectations.

[Some are dead, and some are inside me.]

Watching the Handsome Monkey King continue his chilling tale without any change in expression, I realized anew that the end of the <Star Stream> was truly right in front of us.

「In this worldline, the Great Sage Heaven's Equal did not become 'The Oldest Liberator'.」

I had expected it to some extent, but seeing him unified in an incomplete state made my mind complicated.

「In this turn, the 'myth-grade constellation' Sun Wukong does not exist.」

After looking at the Yangji Jade Vase for a long time, the Handsome Monkey King snapped his head up.

[Wait a minute. Are you... that guy from back then?]

Recognizing me late, the Handsome Monkey King's eyes widened. In fact, I was acquainted with the Handsome Monkey King. I had met him once when doing a scenario related to the 'Twelve Zodiacs' at the 'Recycling Center'.

"Yes. Let me introduce myself again. My name is..."

[Kim Dokja.]

The Handsome Monkey King glared at me as if he detested that name.

[I know. Because I know the 'catastrophe' with the exact same name as yours.]

As if he already knew of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', the Handsome Monkey King spoke without hiding his anger in the slightest.

「Ahead of the destruction of the <Star Stream>, two beings who had lost their brothers faced each other.」

I hid my bitter smile at this ironic play of fate and said:

"Yes. I came to stop that guy."

[Stop... the catastrophe?]

"Yes."

The being in front of me was that 'Handsome Monkey King'. I believed that he, of all people, would understand my heart.

[You are talking nonsense.]

But the Handsome Monkey King's response was cold.

[What on earth are you going to stop! How is someone like you going to stop the 'catastrophe of Ragnarok'? The great catastrophe that even myth-grade constellations couldn't stop—]

"I can do it."

The Handsome Monkey King glared at my calm answer. Then, as if hiding a trembling voice, he said:

[Even if that were possible, it's too late. The battle of 'Ragnarok' already ended two months ago.]

Looking at the 'gate' shrouded in an ominous aura, he added with a sigh:

[Now this world has nothing left but destruction.]

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For a while after that, I sat near the 'gate' and listened to the story of what had happened to the scenario from the Handsome Monkey King.

「During the week I slept in the 'Yangji Jade Vase', two months had already passed outside.」

I thought that might be the case. It was something I had expected ever since I met Ji Eunyu in the 'record archives'. Once again, I had ended up late. But being late was a regular occurrence for me. The important thing was how to make up for that lateness from now on.

[Do you really intend to go to the 'main battlefield'? Even though the battle is over?]

"Yes."

[There will be no constellation to help you.]

"Aren't you here?"

The Handsome Monkey King's face contorted at my cheeky answer.

[It's obvious that entering there will lead to dissipation, so why should I help you?]

"You still want to fight, don't you? Isn't that why you waited here?"

The Handsome Monkey King only pouted his lips without agreeing or denying.

[What do you know...]

Even though he spoke like that, I knew what kind of constellation the Handsome Monkey King was. After mumbling to himself for a while, the Handsome Monkey King suddenly turned his head toward me and asked:

[Were you planning to break the 'gate' and enter?]

"That's right."

[If you force that gate open, there will be a penalty.]

"I don't care."

To be honest, if I hadn't met the Handsome Monkey King, I would have broken the gate and gone up anyway.

[Foolish! If you really intend to go up and fight, why on earth would you do that? How are you going to challenge an opponent you have no chance against even without penalties, while carrying a penalty on your back!]

"So, will you help me?"

The Handsome Monkey King glared at me with his burning Golden Pupils, then answered like a sigh:

[Fine, I'll help.]

I didn't expect him to agree so quickly. Avoiding my gaze, the Handsome Monkey King turned his eyes back to the 'gate' and said:

[The incarnation I cherished often spoke of you.]

I immediately understood whose story that was.

[Even at the moment she sent me here... for some reason, she seemed to be waiting for you.]

"....."

[I thought that if I helped you one last time, she would like it. It's not like I believe you can defeat the catastrophe.]

"What happened to her?"

[Her incarnation body vanished. But I don't know if even her soul has perished. Because she had the power of a 'recorder'.]

That's right. Ji Eunyu was a being who became the 'Recorder of Fear' through her contract with the lump-headed dokkaebi. If so, there was still hope.

"Is it true that the catastrophe used the power of 'the Oldest Dream'?"

The Handsome Monkey King said. Snowfield Kim Dokja exerted the authority of 'the Oldest Dream', and at that moment, half of the stars in 'Ragnarok' disappeared.

[That's right.]

I could vaguely guess what kind of power he had used.

「Interruption of Reading.」

Perhaps 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' had manifested the authority to 'no longer read' some of the constellations existing in this world. But there was something I couldn't understand. If he really was able to use the power of 'the Oldest Dream', there was no need to go through the troublesome effort of reducing the stars by half. Yet the fact that he did such a thing meant...

[That entity is not the only threat. The 'catastrophes of another world' are protecting him. They are terrifying guys who suddenly appeared two months ago.]

Otherworld catastrophes? I wondered who on earth that was referring to for a moment and asked:

"By any chance, have you heard any news about <Kim Dokja's Company>?"

[Kim Dokja's Company?]

The Handsome Monkey King looked at me as if I were talking nonsense. Apparently, the Handsome Monkey King didn't know who <Kim Dokja's Company> referred to.

I thought for a moment and gave an example of one of them.

"Well, with a handsome face—"

[Handsome? How much?]

"You'll know as soon as you see him. And he always wears a black coat..."

[Ah! Was that guy from <Kim Dokja's Company>? If it's him—]

Indeed, no matter what, there was no way he wouldn't recognize Yoo Joonghyuk.

[That guy should still be on the 'main battlefield'.]

The moment I heard his answer, a message rose above the 'gate'.

**[Currently, 97% of the 'Main Battlefield' has been occupied by the 'Catastrophe Camp'.]**

[If all beings belonging to the 'Constellation Camp' perish, the final phase of 'Ragnarok' will begin.]

Three percent. That dizzying number was proof that Yoo Joonghyuk was still fighting in that world.

"Didn't you say the battle was over?"

[It's three percent. Don't you know what that means? It's practically over...]

"I will go meet the other Kings immediately."

According to the Handsome Monkey King, in order to open the 'gate', the consent of the other three Kings, including himself, was required. I thought it was actually better. Beyond that 'gate', the forces of the 'Catastrophe Camp', including Snowfield Kim Dokja, would be waiting. If I could borrow even one more star's hand, it would be a huge help.

But the Handsome Monkey King didn't seem to agree with my thoughts.

[It won't be easy. The other 'Kings' except for me are all...]

It was then that a sound like a jet plane was heard from the sky.

[Damn, one guy has already arrived.]

Along with a massive sonic boom, something was seen descending toward this place. It was a flying vessel of splendid design.

[He's the King of the South. He's called the 'Wealth Emperor' (재황).]

The Wealth Emperor of the South.

[No matter who you are, you'll never be able to convince that guy. He's not someone who listens to anyone in the first place.]

The Handsome Monkey King glared at the flying vessel and frowned.

[He's a miser who knows nothing but coins. Unless you have the spare capacity to give him enough coins to satisfy him, no matter how hard you wag your tongue...]

The moment I saw the familiar emblem engraved on the flying vessel, I wondered, 'No way—'. Soon, the one who got off the flying vessel was an old man in a Hawaiian shirt. The moment he confirmed my face, he recognized me too.

[I wondered who touched the 'gate', and as expected, it was you.]

I was deeply moved to hear his voice after a long time and replied:

"You were here."

[It's been a while.]

Naturally, I thought he would have survived until now. Because he was the star with the most coins in this world.

「Above the throne of coins he had built, he was an existence who lived only to watch the conclusion of this world.」

Perhaps one of the most necessary allies for me right now.

"It's been a long time, Mass Production Maker."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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Note [1]: Note: "Handsome Monkey King" (미후왕 / Mihuwang) is the title of Sun Wukong. (and his brothers who share his name)]

# 1032 Episode 63. Ragnarok (6)

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Even though I didn't say anything, the Mass Production Maker already knew what I wanted to say.

[You want to open that 'gate', don't you?]

Seeing the meaningful expression of the Mass Production Maker, the Handsome Monkey King beside me spoke with a triumphant face.

[Look, from now on, that old man is going to demand something enormous from you.]

His tone was slightly mocking, as if looking forward to what would happen next.

[In order to get the gate's 'key' from that old man, you must—]

But the moment he heard the Mass Production Maker's next words, the Handsome Monkey King blinked foolishly.

[If you want, I will give you the key.]

"Give it to me now."

[I don't have it right now. My hideout is nearby, so stay there for a bit while I look for the key.]

"There is no time."

[I understand how you feel, but there is no need to hurry like that.]

He guided the Handsome Monkey King and me to his flying vessel and said:

[Anyway, the 'main battlefield' is in a lull right now. The final battle won't happen for another four days.]

"Do you know what is happening on the main battlefield?"

The Mass Production Maker smiled without answering. It seemed to mean he would tell me if I followed him.

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After a flight of about ten minutes, we arrived at the Mass Production Maker's hideout. It was a hideout shaped like a giant floating castle, reminiscent of the 'Recycling Center'.

[I will bring the key. The butler will guide you.]

As we entered the hideout, a long corridor appeared. On the corridor walls, the stories of the 'scenario areas' he had collected so far were hung like paintings.

[This bastard. The world is going to ruin, but he's living in such a luxurious place all by himself?]

Listening to the grumbling of the Handsome Monkey King walking beside me, I examined the stories hanging on the corridor walls one by one. Among them were stories I knew well.

「Philia Hunter Academy.」

It was a school my companions and I had attended together once. The school attended by Ma Hyeonsung, the protagonist of "The Infinite Jailer".

「"Dokja-ssi."」

For a moment, dizziness struck along with an unknown pain. A side of my heart throbbed and my legs shook so much that it was hard to walk. But I did not turn on [The Fourth Wall]. I merely took a deep breath, pretending to be calm, and continued to walk down the corridor. Reading the time my companions and I had lived without avoiding anything.

[This way, please.]

Guided by the butler managing the center, we entered the drawing room, where luxurious dishes were prepared on the table.

[What?]

The Handsome Monkey King's eyes widened, and he ran straight to the table and began to stuff his face with the food. Dishes that at a glance recalled fine dining. Above all, what was extraordinary was the ingredients of those dishes.

[Wait a minute. Isn't this the Great Pill of Reincarnation?]

Not truffle, but a sandwich literally ground with the Great Pill of Reincarnation.

[They are peaches of the Peach Orchard! How on earth did he get these? The Queen Mother of the West would never have allowed it.]

Besides those, there was cold buckwheat noodles accompanied by Stalactite Liquid, and sous-vide Dragon Heart dishes. Having swept the table like that, the Handsome Monkey King finally swallowed the elixir of Taishang Lajuon topped on the ice cream served as dessert before speaking to me.

[Hey.]

"Yes?"

[What on earth is your identity? Why is that old man treating you so well?]

I answered while putting the elixir of Taishang Lajuon left on the table into my mouth. The elixir I thought would taste bitter unexpectedly tasted like sweet chocolate.

"Probably because I am Kim Dokja."

It wasn't an answer I expected the Handsome Monkey King to understand. Nevertheless, whatever the Handsome Monkey King was thinking, he stared at me intently and said something unexpected.

[Well, of course. I know that much too.]

After the meal, the Handsome Monkey King hesitated as if he had something to say, then pouted his lips and left the drawing room, saying, "I'll go look around for a bit."

Watching his back vanish with the Out-of-Body Clone technique, I felt like I vaguely knew what he wanted to say to me.

「Perhaps he read the stories of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal of other worldlines in the 'Yangji Jade Vase'.」

Perhaps the reason he vanished was because he wanted to examine the stories of that worldline once more. The eldest brother must have foreseen all of this and sent the Yangji Jade Vase to the Handsome Monkey King of the 41st turn. While grateful for that consideration, my heart felt heavier on the other hand.

「Kim Dokja was now afraid of getting close to anyone.」

I looked around the drawing room, waiting for someone to enter. But neither the butler nor the Mass Production Maker returned.

Sitting in the quiet drawing room on the night before destruction, eating the Great Pill of Reincarnation and the peaches of the Peach Orchard left by the Handsome Monkey King felt extremely strange, but from now on, there was not a single second to waste.

Since things had turned out this way, it was best to handle the deferred tasks first. There were things to check ahead of the final showdown. Messages from constellations or nebulas that had arrived without my knowledge, records left by the recorders. Deferred scenario rewards. And...

[A new chapter of 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' has been updated on the platform.]

After a long time, I accessed the platform through my smartphone.

「The platform where the 'Side Stories' of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint were serialized.」

Fortunately, the connection was smooth this time. I immediately checked the backlog of comments using the 'Daily Free Pass'.

[You have used all of today's allocated 'Daily Free Passes'!]

In the past, I would have stopped reading once the 'Free Passes' were exhausted, but today was different. I read as many comments as possible, even spending additional coins. I remembered or took notes of comments that seemed like they would be of any help. Perhaps because I read a large number of comments, pop-up events appeared in between, giving me free passes.

I also checked the comments of old chapters once more. Then, the faces of the people I had lived that time with rose one by one.

Catching insects in the first scenario with Dansoo ahjussi.

Hunting the first mole cricket with Kyung Sein.

Escaping from the Ichthyosaur with Jung Heewon.

Encountering Cha Sungwoo at the Dark Keeper's hideout.

Talking about my work with Cha Yerin.

Meeting the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st turn and becoming his companion.

The readers also remembered the stories I remembered. Some memories were vivid, while others were faint—but thinking that someone had read all those stories after all made me feel strange.

As it came to the recent chapters, the atmosphere of the comments became darker.

— Is it true? Is it ending like this?

Expressions of sadness or lamentation.

— He's really dying?

Words that didn't feel like there was any hope. Nevertheless, looking at those comments, strangely, my heart became calm.

— I'm rooting for you.

Perhaps it was because of the reader's comment I checked at the very end.

[You still like reading something.]

Suddenly looking up, the 'Mass Production Maker' was in front of my eyes. Somehow, it was a landscape that gave me a sense of déjà vu. The memory of sitting in his passenger seat and reading something while traversing the <Star Stream> came to mind. It was a memory of Kim Dokja that I knew well.

[At that time, you were reading a blank screen.]

"Was I?"

[How is it? Is the sentence you wanted written in that blank space now?]

I stared down at the smartphone screen for a moment, then replied:

"I think I'll only know that when this story is completely finished."

Only now did I seem to understand why the Mass Production Maker brought me here. He was giving me, standing before a dead end, time to look back on all these paths one last time.

"The meal was really delicious."

[I wanted to feed you something. Right now, your incarnation body looks extremely unstable.]

"Thank you for your concern."

Bowing my head, I looked closely at the Mass Production Maker's face. Suddenly, the memory of meeting him for the last time at 'Philia Academy' came to mind. Perhaps the Mass Production Maker also recalled that time, as he spoke to me with an enigmatic smile:

[You have a face that looks much more like the person I knew back then.]

"Are you the 'Mass Production Maker' I know?"

[Who is the 'Mass Production Maker' you know?]

"A star who can spend all the coins he has collected just to see the conclusion he wants."

The Mass Production Maker laughed, whatever he thought of my answer. I looked straight at him and said:

"I need your help."

[But you are not the 'Kim Dokja' I know.]

"But you came all the way here because you were curious about his story, didn't you?"

[Do you really intend to become that 'Kim Dokja'?]

The moment I received his question, the stories inside me squirmed.

[The story 'Demon King of Salvation' begins its narration!]

[The story 'King of Terror' begins its narration!]

[The story 'Prisoner of the Golden Headband' begins its narration!]

In response to his intense desire, the stories inside me reacted first. But the Mass Production Maker looked at me with warm eyes, as if calming the stories down.

[I want to hear your story, not the stories.]

"I am still here as Kim Dokja."

[Is that your will? Or the will of the story?]

I hesitated for a moment before answering.

"Now I cannot distinguish it well either."

[You are indeed honest.]

"Whether we control the stories or are controlled by the stories, what's more important in the end is what we get to see through this story."

As if slightly surprised by my answer, the Mass Production Maker's eyes wavered.

"Mass Production Maker. The fact that you are here even after confirming the ■■ must mean you were not satisfied with that conclusion."

The Mass Production Maker shook his head and replied:

[No, I was satisfied. Perhaps the problem was that it was too satisfying.]

The Mass Production Maker continued with a bitter smile:

[Even though I knew that some afterstories are beautifully completed only when left as blank spaces, I still wanted to check all the blank spaces. Probably because I loved that story too much.]

"....."

[It wouldn't be just me. All the constellations who possessed or descended into this worldline with me would have felt the same way.]

I thought of Uriel whom I met at the 'Recycling Center', and the Great Sage Heaven's Equal whom I met in the 'Bush of the Missing'.

[Actually, I regret it a little. There are times when I think that you ended up like this because we wanted to see the blank spaces of that story.]

Before I could answer that it wasn't so, the Mass Production Maker shook his head.

[Anyway, you have finally come this far. I offer my sincere respect to you.]

"Thank you."

[But main battlefield in your brother is too strong. And by that brother's side, terrifying owners of stories are holding their ground.]

"Who is it?"

The Mass Production Maker did not answer. Instead, looking straight at me with unreadable eyes, he said:

[You will die.]

"Kim Dokja dying is a regular occurrence anyway, isn't it?"

[I want to see a different conclusion.]

It was fresh to realize he was a star capable of making such a worried expression. I grinned and replied:

"Don't worry. A conclusion beyond what you imagined will be waiting."

[The opponent is a 'reader' who has read all the stories of this world.]

"I know."

[Do you really believe you can write a story that will convince him?]

"I can't make such a guarantee. But..."

I recalled the last words Ji Eunyu had left me.

「"I want Kim Dokja to survive this time too."」

Simply chewing over those words again and again, I answered:

"Kim Dokja will definitely survive and see the conclusion he wants. And you will too."

The Mass Production Maker looked at me for a moment, then pulled a splendid key from his chest and handed it to me.

[You have acquired the 'Key of the Wealth Emperor'!]

It was the first key to open the gate of the 'main battlefield'.

[The Handsome Monkey King and I will help you. But I can't guarantee what the other two Kings will do.]

I wasn't surprised since the Handsome Monkey King had already said something similar.

[I know what you're thinking. But the other Kings will really be different from me.]

"I don't care. If they can't be convinced, I'll take the keys by force and go up."

The Mass Production Maker smiled bitterly at my response.

[Unfortunately, you won't be able to do that. Because—]

The sound of thunder was heard from the distant sky. Dark rain was falling over the sky of the <Star Stream> where the starlight had gone out.

[The remaining two 'Kings' are existences you know extremely well.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1033 Episode 63. Ragnarok (7)

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The other 'two Kings' are existences I know extremely well?

A few figures flashed through my mind. I wondered if it could really be, yet at the same time, I felt like it made sense. Of course, either way, I couldn't be sure until I met them.

[Are you finished talking?]

When I came out of the drawing room, the Handsome Monkey King, who was leaning against a pillar in the corridor, spoke to me.

[What was there to talk about so much with that boring old man.]

"We share special memories, you see."

Instead of answering my words, the Handsome Monkey King stared at the story hanging on the opposite hallway. As I stood beside him, the story inside the picture frame moved.

「The Last War.」

It was a story I also knew well. The 1,864th turn, the last war of the stars. The stars filling the night sky shone brightly, and the 'Mass Production Maker' standing below

spent his coins. The Black Flame Dragon roared in the distant sky, and as the wave of the end covered the <Star Stream>, Archangel Uriel's wings emitted a brilliant light. Subsequently, with a roaring sound, Sun Wukong's Ruyi Bang cleaved the night sky.

「That was the story of the stars that Kim Dokja saw for the last time.」

The Handsome Monkey King watched the story in the frame with me, then opened his mouth.

[I read the history of the life you have lived.]

Only then did I realize that the Handsome Monkey King was holding the hair of the Great Sage Heaven's Equal that had been inside the 'Yangji Jade Vase'. Apparently, he had read all the story information contained in that hair while walking down the corridor.

[Don't make the mistake of thinking I will easily trust you just because my brothers from other worldlines trusted you.]

"Aren't you already trusting me?"

[Are you going to look for the other Kings now?]

"Yes. Because we don't have much time."

Twitching his lips as if he had expected it, the Handsome Monkey King quickly pressed close to my side and said:

[Hmph, this time it really won't go the way you want.]

"Why are you following me again while talking like that?"

[Because I must see you fail.]

Although he had a twisted personality, it was reassuring that the Handsome Monkey King was moving with me. The eldest brother probably knew the Handsome Monkey King's personality beforehand and sent his own stories together inside the 'Yangji Jade Vase'.

However, as we stepped out of the corridor's exit, the 'Mass Production Maker', wearing splendid goggles, was waiting, having finished his preparations who knows when.

[I will go with you this time.]

"You're coming with us?"

[You guys don't have a means of transportation to ride anyway, do you?]

I thought there was no reason to decline his kindness, but the Handsome Monkey King, who was eavesdropping beside us, snapped in a sharp voice:

[Hmph, I have the Somersault Cloud.]

[Wasn't that scrap of cloud destroyed on the main battlefield not long ago?]

[Since it's a cloud, a new one will be made soon.]

[Anyway, you don't have it right now, do you?]

The 'Mass Production Maker' smiled and snapped his fingers lightly, and the lower hangar of the 'Recycling Center' opened, revealing a giant flying vessel.

[It's a 'story weapon' I newly made a few years ago. I wondered if I would ever use it, but this is perfect.]

A flying vessel that looked dozens or hundreds of times larger than the one we rode here —it was a weapon of war that was more fittingly called a 'battleship'.

"If we ride something like this, won't they think we're here to fight?"

[Didn't you say you'd subdue them by force if they couldn't be convinced?]

"That was just a figure of speech. How can a person throw punches first? We're not monkeys."

I felt the Handsome Monkey King glaring at me beside us. The Mass Production Maker chuckled and replied:

[If we change the story wavelength to stealth mode, they won't notice even if we ride it. Now, which way will we go? West? Or East?]

Since we met the Monkey King of the North and the Wealth Emperor of the South, this time...

"Let's go to the West first."

[West, huh.]

Seeing the Mass Production Maker's complex and subtle expression, the King of the West also seemed to be an extraordinary existence like them.

[This time, I'll get to watch a fun show indeed. Have you heard who the King of the West is?]

When I shook my head, the Handsome Monkey King shouted with a brightened face:

[I knew it! Don't be surprised, because it's a monster you can't even imagine!]

"I think I'm acquainted with that monster."

[Acquainted?]

Frowning, the Handsome Monkey King turned his gaze toward the Mass Production Maker. It was a look asking what on earth they had discussed. As the Mass Production Maker shrugged without a word, the Handsome Monkey King added with a growl:

[Whether you're acquainted or not, you'll never be able to convince that guy. At least this old man could be reasoned with, but that guy cannot be reasoned with at all!]

"He cannot be reasoned with? Is he a beast?"

[Hehe, if you're that curious, this body can give you a little hint—]

"Well, no. Even beasts seem to communicate..."

[You're not talking about me right now, are you?]

We immediately boarded the 'Mass Production Maker's' battleship. Contrary to its fearsome exterior, the interior of the battleship looked like a party room. Since it was my first time boarding such a large-scale story weapon, curiosity suddenly rose.

"Are battleships of other nebulas like this too?"

[Similar. Though they are older generations than this.]

As far as I knew, many of the 'story weapons' of the giant nebulas were made by the hand of the 'Mass Production Maker'. That was the reason why no giant nebula dared to ignore him despite having only the status of a story-grade constellation. The war munitions contractor with the most coins in this world. That was this old man in a Hawaiian shirt—the 'Mass Production Maker'.

With the sound of the engine starting, the scenery was pushed away in an instant. The battleship began to jump using the power of the hyperdrive. The moment I felt a slight dizziness, the battleship was stopped again.

[We've arrived.]

"Already?"

[It's only within the 'Hall' anyway. A jump of this distance is nothing. However...]

The Mass Production Maker stared beyond the cockpit covered in pitch-black fog. I could tell without listening. Perhaps the 'King of the West' was beyond that pitch-black fog.

[We can't get too close to the habitat of the King of the West. It would be better to disembark and approach from here. He doesn't like anything flying in his airspace.]

"Let's go right away."

I disembarked immediately with the Handsome Monkey King and the Mass Production Maker. Who on earth would be the King waiting for me this time?

Did he feel tension from my expression? The Handsome Monkey King stepped forward casually and said:

[Hmph, no need to be too scared. If worst comes to worst, this body will protect you.]

"Protect me? Weren't you wishing for me to fail?"

[Hmph.]

Looking at the Handsome Monkey King, whom I could not predict at all as he went back and forth, I felt like I could understand a little why Ji Eunyu had been close to him.

[Over there.]

Stopping as soon as we broke through the black fog zone, the Handsome Monkey King pointed to a distant location.

"That is..."

I squinted and looked at the place the Handsome Monkey King pointed. There was a giant nest there.

「Dragon Lair.」

As if proving the Handsome Monkey King's words, spine-chilling howls echoed one after another from beyond the sky. Sensing the intruders, the dragon race let out wild roars toward us.

[It's been a while since I've seen so many of the dragon race gathered.]

From hatchling-class young individuals to large individuals corresponding to ancient dragons. A pack of dragons, looking to be dozens at a glance, was active in the sky. At a glance, it was a force that could lay waste to a single scenario area in an instant.

"I think I know who the King of the West is."

[Then you would also know that convincing him is difficult. Because the current him is not the star you used to know.]

Instead of answering, I took a step forward. Perhaps my pace was too reckless, as the Handsome Monkey King warned:

[Wait. We must move slowly from here on. Or else—]

I ignored his words and increased my walking speed further. Then, as if waiting, the dragons in the sky looked down at me all at once.

[All the dragons in the area roar at you!]

An enormous status poured down on me from the sky. If it had been the past, just receiving that status would have made me cough up blood from my seven orifices and faint. But not now.

[Get out of the way.]

I met the wave of the dragons head-on and burst out a true voice:

[I came to meet your King.]

Surprised by the true voice that vibrated the entire sky, the dragons began to scatter around me. At the same time, a rough story burst out from the distant Dragon Lair.

Oooooo—!

The supreme lifeforms. The dragon race that stood at the absolute apex of all living things. Among them, the dragon that occupied the throne of the King was waking up from a long sleep.

The Dragon King of the West, looking down at me with pitch-black eyes reminiscent of the abyss of distant antiquity. I met his gaze and opened my mouth.

"It's been a long time, Black Flame Dragon."

But the Black Flame Dragon only stared at me with an inorganic gaze as if looking at an inanimate object, without answering. The Handsome Monkey King grimaced and shouted:

[Foolish guy! Do you really think you can talk with that guy? You've provoked him, so the area will soon be covered in flames!]

"But he is also a constellation."

[Do you think all constellations are the same! You don't know what kind of constellation that guy is! That guy is the head of the dragon nebula, Black Cloud. He's an evil dragon who tramples, ravages, and despises all existences he deems inferior to himself!]

The Handsome Monkey King seemed to have accumulated a lot against the Black Flame Dragon, as he swore at the Black Flame Dragon for a long time. And the Black Flame Dragon quietly stared at the Handsome Monkey King swearing right in front of his nose.

[...So... do you understand?]

Thinking this would be enough to convince me, the Handsome Monkey King stopped talking. I gave a bitter smile toward the Handsome Monkey King, then looked up at the Black Flame Dragon again.

The Black Flame Dragon was yawning. It was a very long yawn.

[Are you done chattering, monkey?]

The Handsome Monkey King turned to the Black Flame Dragon with a blank expression. Then he asked back incredulously:

[What? You—knew how to speak?]

[Are there constellations who cannot speak?]

[When I visited last time...]

[I merely didn't want to exchange words with a trivial beast.]

The Handsome Monkey King released his status as if he could no longer stand it. The Black Flame Dragon also slowly raised his fighting spirit. Thus, at the very moment their untimely war of nerves was about to break out, I cut into the context of the stories.

"Black Flame Dragon. Do you remember me?"

The 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' looked at me. Slowly lowering his fighting spirit, he spoke to me in a deep true voice:

[I remember your story.]

I smiled at the Black Flame Dragon. From the moment I first heard there were four 'Kings' here, I thought that one of those 'Kings' might be the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon. This place was a stage built on the foundation of the 'super-large battlefield' of the Preliminary Battle, and the Black Flame Dragon had descended on the 'super-large battlefield' to face Mitra before.

[Your story resonates with the constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon'!]

At that time, I had saved the Black Flame Dragon who was controlled by Asmodeus.

[But I am not the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' you knew.]

"It seems so."

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon I knew was a mischievous kid who simulated being '15 years old' by himself. But the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' in front of my eyes now was by no means a 15-year-old kid. The reason was clear.

「The 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' in front of me is an existence born from the side effect of the 'Disconnected Film Theory'.」

The new 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' born from the mixing of the stories of the 1,864th turn and the 41st turn. That was the monster coiled in front of my eyes now.

[I know about the Black Flame Dragon you miss. His stories and emotions still remain inside me.]

Lifting his neck loftily, he stared at the sky of the <Star Stream> where no stars were visible, then added in a somewhat cold tone:

[However, do not expect his warmth from me.]

As if listening to the story was the maximum extent of his favor, no warmth could be felt from the Black Flame Dragon's voice. But instead of being discouraged, I grinned.

"I didn't come expecting that."

The Black Flame Dragon tilted his head as if measuring my intent and asked:

[Why did you come here?]

"Black Flame Dragon. Do you want to end your ■■ here?"

A cold light momentarily lodged in the Black Flame Dragon's eyes looking down at me. Even among the same constellations, their reactions to ■■ are all different. Some constellations like talking about it, while others get angry just by it being mentioned. And perhaps, to the current 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon'—

"I know why you are here."

His ■■ would be his reverse scale.

「In the worldline of the 41st turn, the 'Great War of Saints and Demons' did not occur.」

The 'Great War of Saints and Demons' was prevented by Snowfield Kim Dokja, and thus, the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' did not even get the chance to become the 'Last Dragon of the Apocalypse'. The dragon born only to reign as a catastrophe had fallen before he could even spread his wings.

"I mean I understand why you signed a recording contract with a recorder like the 'Demon King of the Theater'."

The reason the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' signed a recording contract with Asmodeus was probably not just because of the instability of his true body. He now had no expectations for the future. The universe of the <Star Stream>, where the starlight he would extinguish had vanished, could no longer excite him.

[No, you do not understand me.]

I nodded.

"I suppose so. Because right now, a blank space as vast as the distance between stars lies between us."

[The story 'Opponent of the Dragon' continues its narration.]

Nevertheless, we were clearly connected. Through stories and stories. That was why I didn't give up. Not understanding each other didn't mean we couldn't converse. Having different species or possessing different stories didn't mean we couldn't talk.

「If you write nothing in the blank space out of fear of failure, the blank space will only remain a blank space forever.」

Perhaps Kim Dokja would have thought the same if he saw the current Black Flame Dragon.

"Abyssal Black Flame Dragon."

Staring at his massive body, I felt some strong fate. Coming all the way here, meeting them at this particular time—I felt that perhaps all of it was part of a giant foreshadowing.

「Everything is already written, and at the same time, is being written.」

And so, if all of this is truly already written, and at the same time, is being written.

[Currently, you are the recorder of the constellation 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon'.]

Then I, too, with all the capacity given to me—

"Do you want to become the 'Final Dragon of the Apocalypse' once again?"

I will try to become the 'Kim Dokja' of this story.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1034 Episode 63. Ragnarok (8)

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[Are you speaking sincerely?]

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon's expression turned fierce. As expected, he was looking forward to becoming the strongest catastrophe of the <Star Stream> once again.

[But you must also know. This is 'Ragnarok'.]

"What about it? Is the Final Dragon of the Apocalypse not allowed to descend in 'Ragnarok'?"

The Black Flame Dragon stared at me quietly, then said:

[You came to get the 'key' from me. Is that right?]

As I nodded, the Black Flame Dragon's eyes narrowed.

[Do you know what is inside that 'gate'?]

"I know."

[No one in the <Star Stream> can defy 'the Oldest Dream'.]

"That dream is not yet complete."

I looked up at the sky and said:

"And if you really gave up on everything, there would be no reason for you to wait for the final scenario of all places here."

[I have no intention of fighting a foolish battle against an opponent I cannot defeat.]

"The Black Flame Dragon I know doesn't talk like that."

[I am—]

"I know. But you are also the Black Flame Dragon I know."

I could tell. Inside him, the 'story' of the Black Flame Dragon I knew was definitely present.

"The Black Flame Dragon I know was a star who loved unwinnable battles the most."

I remembered him challenging the previous Apocalypse Dragon in the 'Great War of Saints and Demons'. The Black Flame Dragon who fought to the death using all his stories even though he knew he would lose.

Frowning slightly, the Black Flame Dragon countered:

[That is not me.]

"Do you really think so?"

The Black Flame Dragon could not answer. Ultimately, a single being is the sum total of the stories that compose it. Like it or not, the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' of the 1,864th turn was now a part of him. And he had to live with that story.

"What I want is not merely the 'key'. It is to see the end of all scenarios. I want you to be there in that conclusion."

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon still didn't answer. I continued speaking:

"Just because the night sky is dark doesn't mean all the stars have set. There is light that can only be seen in the darkest sky."

[I saw your story. It was miserable and terrible.]

I felt like I vaguely knew what story he had seen. It was probably Kim Dokja's story witnessed by the Black Flame Dragon of the 1,864th turn.

[Why do you want to see the end once more despite having gone through all of that?]

"Because I went through all of that."

Neither the recorder who records the stories, the constellations who live by reading the stories, nor the Outer Gods who struggle because they cannot be recorded anywhere—actually, no one knows the conclusion of the universe.

"I am curious. What kind of landscape is the conclusion of the universe that we must reach after going through all those stories—the final story I must write."

Even while saying that everything is already written and, at the same time, is being written—why do they always yearn for the ■■ so much?

"Aren't you the same?"

Instead of answering, the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon looked up at the sky I was looking at. Perhaps he also needed time to think.

"I'll wait for an hour. If you change your mind, come out of the nest."

*

For about an hour after that, the Handsome Monkey King and I paced in front of the Black Flame Dragon's nest. Occasionally, young hatchlings watching us from a distance waddled closer and then moved away repeatedly.

Yawning repeatedly while watching the dragons, the Handsome Monkey King asked:

[Do you think he'll come out?]

"I don't know either."

[Your expression looks like you're sure he will.]

"How much have you even seen to be reading my expressions already?"

In the distance, the Mass Production Maker, who had gone to fetch supplies from the battleship, could be seen waving as he returned.

[Hmm, is it not time yet? It feels like it's almost been an hour.]

"58 minutes have passed."

[I'll bet 100 coins that he comes out in 2 minutes.]

When the Mass Production Maker laughed and made a bet, the Handsome Monkey King immediately chipped in.

[Then I'll bet 100 coins that he doesn't come out!]

It felt strange to watch two constellations representing the <Star Stream> betting a mere 100 coins each. Nevertheless, the two waited for the time with serious eyes.

1 minute, and 2 minutes. Finally, an hour passed, but the Black Flame Dragon did not show himself.

[See, as expected, he didn't...!]

With a rumbling sound, a vibration echoed from inside the nest. Shortly after, the Black Flame Dragon walked out of the nest with his wings folded. As the Handsome Monkey King gaped blankly, the Mass Production Maker poked his shoulder and held out his palm. Grimacing, the Handsome Monkey King pulled out 100 coins.

Had he not come out of the nest in a long time? The Black Flame Dragon twisted his body lightly as if stretching, then looked down at me with his erect massive body and said:

[I merely became a little interested in your blank space.]

I nodded lightly to the Black Flame Dragon and said:

"That's enough."

Now, only the last King remained.

*

The last King of the Hall was the 'King of the East'. This time too, the one who provided the information was the Mass Production Maker.

[In the territory of the King of the East, a poison fog is spread.]

"A poison fog?"

[It's a highly toxic fog strong enough to corrode even story metals.]

If it was strong enough to corrode not other metals but story metals, it was certainly no ordinary fog. I didn't know, but it was probably a fog in which the story of a very powerful constellation was lodged.

[I heard it is the deadly poison emitted by the corpse of the 'World Snake' that died on the 'super-large battlefield' before.]

The World Snake. The moment I heard those words, a scene immediately rose. Right before I entered the 'Bush of the Missing', I had seen the 'World Snake' fighting against Mitra. In fact, the constellation who descended as the catastrophe of the Preliminary Battle, the 'World Snake', was an existence I knew well.

"Yamata no Orochi."

The Eight-Headed Lord, Yamata no Orochi. It seemed he had finally died on this 'super-large battlefield'.

"Who killed him?"

[The King of the East. I heard he cut off all the heads of the 'World Snake' in a single strike.]

If he could cut off all the heads of Orochi, who was strong even among story-grade existences, in a single slash, it meant the last King was also a super-strong being who was not inferior to the other Kings.

[The poison fog in that area clears up in the morning. Let's wait a bit and depart when dawn arrives.]

I thought for a moment and nodded. In fact, whether it was a poison fog or not, I could probably push my way through using [The Fourth Wall] or the stories I possessed. But strangely, I didn't feel like doing that now. To be precise, it felt like I shouldn't.

What was so amusing? The Mass Production Maker was rummaging through the supply box he brought earlier and pulling something out.

In the spare time, I checked the contents of 'Ways of Survival', the main story, and the comments on the newly uploaded chapter one by one.

— Hang in there, ■■.

There wasn't much added to the comments of the latest chapter. But just by confirming the warmth contained in that small encouragement, something inside me was clearly changing.

Sizzle.

Smelling something delicious from somewhere, I turned around and saw the Mass Production Maker, who had set up a grill, roasting something like skewers.

"What are you doing?"

[This is the mass-produced skewer meal kit I recently launched.]

No, I wondered if he even launched something like that as a meal kit.

[I launched it under a contract with the Supreme King.]

"The Supreme King? Do you mean Yoo Joonghyuk?"

[Is there another Supreme King?]

I doubted my eyes for a moment. Looking closely at the meal kit packaging, Yoo Joonghyuk holding a skewer like a spear was drawn.

— Mass-Produced Yoo Joonghyuk Skewers.

— Feel the memories of old scenarios with mole cricket breast meat made with the Supreme King's special sauce.

Were there people who bought such things in this worldline? As if answering my curiosity, the 'Mass Production Maker' smiled.

[It's popular among the angels of <Eden>.]

"When on earth did you sign a contract for this?"

[It's been quite a while. He came to see me a while ago saying he needed a lot of coins, so I thought it was a good opportunity and signed a contract.]

He needed a lot of coins? What on earth was he doing that required so many coins?

Anyway, the smell was good.

"Can I taste it?"

[Wait just a moment.]

Meanwhile, smelling it, the Handsome Monkey King also crept close and asked:

[Oh, is it meat?]

Even the dragons hanging around nearby polymorphed one by one into human forms and peeked this way. Among them was the waddling hatchling from earlier. The Mass Production Maker handed a long skewer to the curious hatchling and said:

[Here, do you want to try it too?]

Instead of roasting the skewer, the hatchling wreathed in a bright smile and munched down the skewer the Mass Production Maker handed over.

[Oops, little guy. It's not fully cooked yet!]

But the other dragons, except for the hatchling, didn't approach easily, as if they were wary of us. Except for a tall man who wended his way through them.

[What kind of dish is that?]

Pitch-black hair falling below his shoulders. The black suit the man wore made his white face stand out even more. At first, I didn't recognize who he was. But the moment I scrutinized his eyes, I realized who the man was and was startled.

"Abyssal Black Flame Dragon?"

At my question, the Black Flame Dragon tilted his head and asked:

[Why are you looking like that?]

"Is that your polymorphed form?"

If the 15-year-old Black Flame Dragon grew up, did he look like this? He looked to be about 30 years old... Surely it wasn't because two 15-year-olds merged, making him 30.

[It's the appearance of my father.]

"Your father is extremely handsome."

Hearing that, I thought anew that there were still many things I didn't know about him. I knew he was the master of the Black Cloud and a regular of the Kim Dokja channel, but I didn't know what history he had lived. Let alone his true name.

"Come to think of it, what is your true name?"

[My name is Abrax...]

[Here, receive one each.]

The Black Flame Dragon's next words were cut off by the skewer the Mass Production Maker held out. We exchanged glances for a moment and immediately tore into the skewers. The meaty aroma of the roasted skewers was quite good. The taste of the Yanaspleta stems inserted in between was also a delicacy, and above all, the seasoning felt really similar to what Yoo Joonghyuk made.

— What are you doing right now?

A small alarm rose in the air. It was a message from the Demon King of Salvation.

"I'm eating Yoo Joonghyuk skewers."

— Yoo Joonghyuk? Is that bastard there?

I smiled bitterly and briefly explained what the situation was. As expected, the Demon King of Salvation responded with disbelief.

— Is this a time to be leisurely eating skewers? I'm busy to death right now.

"Is something wrong?"

— I adjusted the library system a bit through the function of [The Fourth Wall]. You have the ability to read comments through that platform app or whatever, right?

"Yes."

— Now you can use it without turning on the app.

"How?"

— Because you can see the comments here too.

"Oh..."

— From now on, I'll pay to check the comments and project them to you.

If that were possible, a kind of 'pseudo-future sight' might be possible by reading comments in real-time even during combat. As far as I knew, the 'latest chapter' of the serialized version wrote slightly ahead into the future.

I was quite impressed, then realized something and asked back.

"Wait, but isn't that my account?"

— It is, right?

"And the payment is made with my money too."

— Of course.

Was it an illusion? It sounded like the Kim Dokja inside [The Fourth Wall] was just bored and had hijacked my account to read comments.

— Anyway, is it delicious? Still, it's not as good as the one Yoo Joonghyuk made, right?

"Well."

I spoke while tearing into the skewer again.

"It's decent in its own way."

A few steps away, the dragons that gathered one by one could be seen carefully reaching out toward the skewers. I reached for a new skewer and said:

"I know too. That this isn't a time to be leisurely eating skewers."

It wasn't as if my mind was at ease. Entering the main battlefield was just ahead, and once I entered the 'gate', I would now face the worst enemy in <Star Stream>'s history.

"But I felt like I would never see this kind of scenery again."

Reaching for the same skewer, the Handsome Monkey King and the Black Flame Dragon glared at each other. Then, the Mass Production Maker burst into a hearty laugh watching the two constellations.

[The exclusive skill 'The Fourth Wall' shakes minutely.]

A gaze felt beyond the wall. Perhaps the Kim Dokjas inside the wall were also watching this scene right now.

The Demon King of Salvation said:

— Maknae.

"Yes."

He called me and said nothing more. But I already knew what he wanted to say.

In the lonely night sky, there were three shining stars. Together with these stars, we had cleared scenarios, eaten delicious things, quarreled, talked, and lived while talking again. Perhaps during all that time, we were always dreaming the same dream.

「The old journey has now become a cherished memory.」

Together with the Kim Dokjas inside me, I imagined the moment when all this adventure first started, the world we had wanted to possess so much.

[For the few remaining stars of this universe!]

When the Mass Production Maker raised his cup with a toast, the other two constellations also raised their cups as if it were a hassle. I also drank a cup lightly. The alcohol was sweet, but there was no feeling of getting drunk. Before I knew it, the deep night passed and dawn was breaking.

Now it was time to meet the last King.

*

As soon as day broke, we took the battleship and warped to the East. As soon as we disembarked in the eastern zone of the Hall, the ground that had turned light green caught our eye first.

[Over there is his stronghold.]

Was it because the poison fog had just cleared? The eastern zone had a somewhat dreary atmosphere. Looking closely, inside the fog area, something like mud huts were lined up here and there.

"Are there incarnations living here?"

[There are incarnations, and there are constellations.]

"I thought you said there was poison fog?"

[Those who submit to the King of the East are not affected by the poison fog.]

As we approached, incarnations who spotted us here and there could be seen hiding inside the mud huts. I quietly observed the stories they emitted, then walked inward.

In the distance, a giant structure that looked like the residence of the King of the East was visible. Looking closely, as expected, it was the corpse of a constellation. The incarnation body left behind by the Eight-Headed Lord, Yamata no Orochi. From inside the giant snake that scattered ominous stories, the presence of the King of the East was felt.

The Handsome Monkey King spoke in a warning tone.

[The Mad Emperor of the East. He is called that.]

"Are you warning me in advance that he won't be reasoned with again?"

[Yes. Because the Mad Emperor is a crazy guy.]

"Metaphorically?"

[No, the guy is literally crazy.]

The closer we got to Orochi's corpse, the more I felt like I understood those words. The thick and deep stories billowing out from inside the corpse.

「It was madness.」

Just by getting close, one felt as if they would be infected by the madness, deeply despairing of everything in this world—a very deep and gloomy madness.

"How did he end up crazy?"

[He...]

The one who answered this time was not the Handsome Monkey King, but the Mass Production Maker. Staring at the severed neck of Orochi visible in the distance, the Mass Production Maker added in a voice mixed with strange awe and lamentation:

[Of our four 'Kings', he is the only existence who has challenged 'Snow White'.]

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# 1035 Episode 63. Ragnarok (9)

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The only existence among the four 'Kings' who has challenged 'Snow White'. If so, is this story flowing out in front of my eyes now the side effect of the Mad Emperor facing 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'?

[Hey, wait—]

Despite the Mass Production Maker's restraint, I didn't stop and approached the corpse of the World Snake. Looking closely, the snake had a long cut wound not only on its head but also on its torso. A cut wound deep enough to slip inside. The moment I gently put my palm on the snake's hide, I was startled.

It was hot.

A strong heat was flowing from inside the World Snake's hide. If it weren't for the snake's skin, it was an excessive heat that would have cooked everything in this vicinity.

Lifting my status as much as possible, I lifted the split snake hide. Taking a step forward while enduring the hot wind that felt like it would cook my body, I saw a cavity of ashes spread out where the snake's organs should have been. The inside of the cavity was filled with the poison gas emitted by Orochi's corpse, and in the center of the poison gas, a flame that burned everything was blazing.

In the middle of the flames sat the Mad Emperor cross-legged with disheveled hair.

I called the Mad Emperor's name.

"Heewon-ssi."

The Mad Sword Emperor of the 41st turn. The one who had jumped into the 'Bush of the Missing' with me, then escaped the bush with Yoo Joonghyuk—she was standing there, having become the 'Mad Emperor'.

「During the week I slept in the 'Yangji Jade Vase', two months of time had passed outside.」

What on earth had happened during those two months for Jung Heewon to be called the Mad Emperor?

「While I was away, she went up to the 'main battlefield' and fought against 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.」

I calmly called her name once more.

"Heewon—"

At that very moment, Jung Heewon snapped her eyes open. In the brief instant I exchanged glances with her, I instinctively realized that something was wrong.

「She is not the 'Jung Heewon' I know.」

[The 'Madness' of the character has reached its limit!]

[The exclusive attribute 'Butcher of Madness' is running wild!]

I lowered my head reflexively. Then, along with the sound of hair being cut, something sharp brushed above my head.

Formless Sword Qi.

A terrifying sword qi that even sliced through Orochi's hide cut my hair, tore the hide, and flew outward.

「She really intended to kill me.」

I didn't want to admit that fact, so I shouted at Jung Heewon again:

"Heewon-ssi! It's me! Don't you recognize me?"

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. ???' is activated!]

"I am Kim Dokja!"

No matter what state Jung Heewon was in, my [Incite] which had reached its limit should have been effective. Yet why? Jung Heewon's expression darkened even further under my [Incite]. Along with terrifying murder intent, Formless Sword Qi burst out from her entire body once more. What was amazing was that she didn't even draw her sword, nor did she stand up from her seat. Cold sweat formed on my spine.

If my guess was correct, she had definitely reached a new realm of transcendence.

「Mind Sword.」

A realm where one could turn their own will into a blade. If she could pour out such attacks without breathing, it was natural that not just Orochi, but even Orochi's grandfather would be no match for her.

I pulled out 'Unbroken Faith' and hurriedly deflected the Formless Sword Qi. But I couldn't block all the sword qi.

[Damn it! I knew this would happen!]

Entering through the heat a beat late, the Handsome Monkey King shouted as he deflected the Formless Sword Qi:

[Didn't I say she was crazy!]

The Handsome Monkey King seemed to know well that Jung Heewon was in this state.

[She's someone who cannot be reasoned with! She's a fellow who throws bizarre slashes out of nowhere! Furthermore—]

The Handsome Monkey King's eyes glared at Jung Heewon. Looking at the flames rising on those pupils, I was also thinking the same thing.

「Why is Jung Heewon's entire body burning in flames?」

Those flames were not the unique ability of the 41st turn's Jung Heewon. Yet, the fact that her entire body was enveloped in those flames meant...

[The story 'Regret, Ruin, Obsession' is running wild!]

I stared at her stories and made up my mind. As expected, there was only one way to find out.

"Handsome Monkey King. Please buy me some time."

[Are you going to fight? To kill?]

"No, just take a few hits of Formless Sword Qi instead of me. It seems possible with your [Out-of-Body Clone]."

[This bastard thinks my clones are some kind of meat shield...]

"You just need to pluck a few hairs."

[A guy who doesn't even know how precious hair is...!]

Even while speaking like that, the Handsome Monkey King immediately plucked his hair and summoned clones. Instantly dividing, twelve clones charged toward Jung Heewon at the same time.

Kwakwakwakwa!

The Handsome Monkey King's clones fought hard but could not endure the barrage of pouring Formless Sword Qi. But it didn't matter.

「Activate 'Demon King of Salvation' mode.」

Instantly activated star symbols rose over my incarnation body. Activating [Miniaturization] and [Character Transformation] at the same time, I flew toward Jung Heewon like a meteor.

Sgagaak!

The moment the Handsome Monkey King's last clone collapsed after taking the Formless Sword Qi on my behalf, I deactivated [Miniaturization] and [Character Transformation] simultaneously and arrived right in front of Jung Heewon.

"Heewon-ssi."

When my hand touched her forehead, a pain arose as if my hand would burn as it was. Enduring that pain with [The Fourth Wall], I spoke:

[The exclusive skill 'Incite Lv. ???' is activated!]

"Please endure it for a bit."

Together with those words, I used [Bookmark]. Perhaps this madness could not be calmed by [Incite] alone. For reasons unknown, this madness was resisting my [Incite] particularly fiercely. In the end, it meant calming it from the outside was difficult. If so, I had to find the culprit causing this madness inside her inner self.

"I am..."

And as it happened, I knew a character who could delve deeper into an opponent's 'inner self' than anyone else.

"The Salvation Cult Leader, 'Nirvana Moebius'."

Along with my declaration, Nirvana's exclusive skill activated from my palm touching her forehead.

[The exclusive skill 'One Hundred and Eight Agonies Lv. ???' is activated!]

When I opened my eyes again, I was standing in pitch-black darkness.

「This is Jung Heewon's inner self.」

The turbid underground air. The smell of burning mixed acridly. A faint metallic scent. The feel of the solid floor. As my eyes adjusted to the dim surroundings, I quickly got a sense of where this was.

「Subway.」

There was no doubt about it. This was a subway. Among them, it was the platform of a station I knew very well.

「Geumho Station Platform.」

I first met Jung Heewon here. Perhaps because the memory of that time rose anew, a side of my chest throbbed.

「Jung Heewon. She was the first 'character' who became my companion.」

Whether I was 'Cheon Inho' or 'Kim Dokja'. The person who stood by my side regardless of what name I was called.

"Heewon-ssi!"

I couldn't even care for her heart to let my companion end up in this state.

"Heewon-ssi! Can you hear me?"

No matter where I looked on the platform, she was nowhere to be seen. Instead, in the center of the platform sat a strange, unfamiliar container I had never seen before.

Is it there?

It was a worn container that at a glance looked like a convenience store building. The door was closed, but a faint light was leaking through the gap in the door.

As I carefully approached the container, the sound of light music was heard from inside. The sound of someone humming was also heard.

I knocked on the door of the container carefully. But perhaps because the music was too loud, there was no response from inside.

After hesitating for a moment, I carefully pulled the doorknob. And the next moment.

[Aaaah, who is it!]

Along with a rough voice, a clattering sound was heard from inside. Startled, I took a step back, and the door swung open, revealing the owner of the container.

[F-Fuck, who dares to enter someone else's room without—]

The moment I heard the voice, a deep sigh escaped. Perhaps ever since I saw those flames, I had been thinking of her all along.

[Ah.]

Confirming my face, she opened her mouth. Ruffled blonde hair on a pink pajama. A constellation staring blankly at me while scattering white feathers was there.

I smiled at my Archangel whom I had missed for a long time.

"It's been a long time, Teacher Yang."

Demon-like Judge of Fire. Archangel Uriel.

*

When I first heard the story of the King of the East, I thought Archangel Uriel would be here. Because the 'Kings' here were mostly the 'oldbie constellations' of the Kim Dokja Channel.

「As if an unnamed recorder was trying to fit the puzzle of the final 'scenario'.」

Handsome Monkey King, Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, and even the Mass Production Maker. With all the prominent constellations gathered, I thought there was no way Uriel wouldn't be here.

Above all, the 'East' was Uriel's direction even in the main story.

「The Outer God of the 999th turn, the 'Living Flame' rising from the East.」

Since Uriel, who became an Outer God, was also called by such a name, it was natural that the last 'King of the East' would be Uriel. Even if Uriel wasn't the King of the East, I believed she was connected to Uriel in some way.

[I-I mean, you see...]

Staring for a moment at Uriel whose legs were shaking, I looked around the inside of Uriel's container filled with all kinds of little Kim Dokja dolls.

[This! Don't look at this! More than that, the reason I was here is—]

Uriel began to lay out a lengthy explanation. Watching her stutter and even chew on her fingers, I let out a light sigh.

"Uriel."

I didn't know why she was here, but I knew better than anyone that there was no way she would be here with bad intentions.

「She is the Uriel of the 1,864th turn.」

I quietly looked at Uriel. The last time I saw her was at the Recycling Center. There, she had acted as 'Teacher Yang'. At that time, Uriel had descended with half-god status in the scenario to save us in danger, and while enduring the Probability, she fought against constellations including Poseidon.

Since then, contact had been lost and I had been worried all along...

"I'm really glad you are alive."

At my words, Uriel's eyes trembled greatly. She twitched her lips as if wanting to say something, then dropped her head deeply. Though her face was not visible, her shoulders were trembling faintly.

I slowly reached out and wrapped my hand around her shoulder. There was a warmth felt from her shoulder. It was the story of the archangel who had crossed distant worldlines to come all the way here just to save a single person.

"Thank you."

Just as the Great Sage Heaven's Equal did, the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon did, and the Mass Production Maker did. Her reason for coming here was also clear. Because I understood that heart better than anyone, I said to comfort her:

"Don't worry. I will definitely make the conclusion you wanted to see."

I didn't know what Uriel had sacrificed to come to this worldline. Even if I didn't know, I knew her sacrifice was by no means small. That was what crossing worldlines was. She deserved to check the conclusion corresponding to her sacrifice more than anyone in this world.

[No, I got to see you. That's enough for me.]

I didn't know how to answer those words, so I only gave a faint smile. Or rather, the Kim Dokja she wanted was not me. Nevertheless, I was the only Kim Dokja who could speak to her now.

"Is it okay for you to be here? There should be an issue with probability."

[It's fine. When I explained the situation to the 41st turn's me, she readily lent me her incarnation body.]

Fortunately, Uriel seemed to communicate well with her other-worldline self. I asked, somewhat relieved:

"You've been protecting Heewon-ssi here, haven't you?"

Uriel nodded faintly.

[Well, how that happened was...]

According to Uriel's story, it was roughly a month and a half ago when she met Jung Heewon who fell into madness. Having barely recovered from the blow received at the

'Recycling Center' and re-entered the 41st turn, she received a call from someone upon entry.

"Was that Heewon-ssi?"

[No, the one who called me wasn't Heewon.]

"Then who..."

A face flashed through my mind. An incarnation of this world who had a connection with the Archangel Uriel of the 1,864th turn and could cheekily ask for her help.

「"Archangel."」

As far as I knew, there was only one such guy.

「"I need your help."」

The Supreme King of the 41st turn, Yoo Joonghyuk.

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# 1036 Episode 63. Ragnarok (10)

Yoo Joonghyuk summoned Uriel of the 1,864th turn. It wasn't an impossible task. He had previously escaped the 'Recycling Center' and confirmed the physical descent of the Uriel before his eyes, establishing a link with her. The problem was that that prideful guy had actually asked a constellation for help.

"So, what happened? Where was that bastard?"

[The main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'.]

It seemed Yoo Joonghyuk and Jung Heewon had headed straight there as soon as they escaped the 'Bush of the Missing'. At that time, Yoo Joonghyuk had tied three people to his spear and escaped.

「Lee Hyunsung. Shin Yoosung. And Jung Heewon.」

Thinking back, I hadn't heard what happened to the other two besides Jung Heewon.

"Who was Yoo Joonghyuk with? Was it only Heewon-ssi?"

[Yeah, it was like that when I went.]

I felt a bit disappointed. After all, Lee Hyunsung and Shin Yoosung were members of <Kim Dokja's Company> from the 1,864th turn. If they had remained by Yoo Joonghyuk's

side, it would have certainly been a great help.

...Well, whatever. Right now, finding out Jung Heewon's exact condition was more important.

"Was Heewon-ssi injured? I heard she fought against Snowfield Kim Dokja."

Uriel shook her head as if she didn't know that far.

[When I arrived, Heewon was already unconscious. She was emitting a cold chill from her entire body... for me, applying urgent treatment was the most I could do.]

I quickly realized what that treatment was.

"So the heat coming from Heewon-ssi's body was indeed..."

[That's right. It's my story.]

As expected, that story originated from Uriel's [Hellfire].

"Was there no other conversation with Yoo Joonghyuk? Didn't he tell you how Heewon-ssi ended up like this?"

[I didn't hear the details. It wasn't a situation where I could stay there for long.]

After leaving Jung Heewon to Uriel, Yoo Joonghyuk immediately ordered them to leave.

「"Archangel. Take that woman and escape the 'main battlefield'. Right now."」

That was the last message Yoo Joonghyuk left. Uriel pursed her lips with a gloomy expression, perhaps remembering that time.

[Actually, there were many things I wanted to ask... but there was no other way. It was clear that Heewon would die if she stayed there. The army of catastrophes was approaching.]

It seemed Yoo Joonghyuk had hurriedly evacuated Jung Heewon right before the war with the catastrophes broke out. Since Jung Heewon's body was freezing in real-time, Uriel said she brought her to the 'Hall' and treated her all this time.

[I bought and fed her the Great Return Pill and elixirs imbued with Solar energy, but they had no effect.]

That was strange. Originally, incarnation bodies exposed to cold or Yin energy, including the Nine Yin Severed Meridians, can show improved symptoms if they consume elixirs containing hot Yang energy. But if the elixirs had no effect, there was only one answer.

"So there's a problem with Heewon-ssi's soul."

Perhaps while facing 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', a crack had formed in Jung Heewon's soul itself. In other words, the cold that was killing her was leaking from her very soul.

[Right now, the most I can do is warm her with my story so she doesn't die. Ah, there was one time when Heewon regained consciousness, though...]

"Was it when we killed the World Snake?"

[That's right.]

She said Jung Heewon, who had been unconscious all along, woke up with a nostalgic look in her eyes the moment she saw Yamata-no-Orochi's head.

"A nostalgic look?"

[Yeah. I can't describe it any other way.]

Jung Heewon slew Yamata-no-Orochi with those 'nostalgic eyes' and lost consciousness again. More precisely, she didn't lose consciousness, but closed the door to her soul while maintaining a subconscious state, as if she were dreaming.

Then was it Jung Heewon's subconscious that fired the Formless Sword Qi at me? It was hard to believe she could show such ridiculous power even in an unconscious state. In the two months I hadn't seen her, Jung Heewon had taken another leap into the realm of transcendence.

"Where is Heewon-ssi now?"

If this was the inside of Jung Heewon's mind, her soul would surely be somewhere here. Uriel let out a weak sigh and gestured to me.

[Follow me.]

I quietly followed behind Uriel. In the dark tunnel, her two wings fluttered outside her training suit. Perhaps because she had suffered so much in the meantime, her wings were heavily damaged.

I stared into the pitch-black tunnel and said,

"It feels strange."

[Huh? What is?]

"It's because this is the first time I've walked side-by-side with you like this."

Uriel looked back, startled, and laughed.

[Ah, ah. Right? Ahaha.]

The star that became infinitely serious when it came to things involving Jung Heewon, but fell apart completely in front of her favorite incarnation. The only star that did not wish for Kim Dokja's death until the very, very end.

I bowed my head and greeted her once again.

"Thank you so much for back then at the Recycling Center."

[No, I went because I wanted to.]

Thinking back, this was practically the first time I was speaking with her properly. When she was 'Teacher Yang', both of us had to speak in line with our concepts anyway. Perhaps Uriel was conscious of that too, as she kept walking slightly ahead with tentative steps instead of walking side-by-side.

I slowly followed behind her.

「At a distance of exactly three steps away, Uriel was walking with light, fluttering steps.」

In writing terms, a gap as wide as a single space. A close distance, but an interval that ultimately prevented us from becoming the same word. Yet a distance where we could still become a single sentence together. We kept walking, leaving exactly that much blank space between us.

As we walked, I thought that perhaps this was the right distance for us. Star and human. Constellation and incarnation. From this distance, she had watched Kim Dokja's story all this time.

"Thank you for protecting Heewon-ssi."

[She's my incarnation, after all. No, of course, she isn't my incarnation yet in this worldline—]

Watching her hair sway in the darkness, I knew Uriel was grinning.

[Because the Heewon of this world is still Heewon.]

"Just like how Uriel in any world is still Uriel."

She probably didn't know what kind of comfort her broad smile brought me.

Perhaps she had relaxed a bit; as we walked along the tracks of the platform, Uriel began talking on her own.

[Did you know? Back at Geumho Station, when you and the kids fought the mole cricket —]

Uriel began talking disjointedly. It was the first time I was hearing about those days directly from Uriel's own mouth. A story from the time when all these scenarios first began.

Instead of just listening to her story, I memorized her expression and tone as she talked excitedly. Thinking that if the real Kim Dokja returned someday, I would definitely tell him about this bright star reflecting in my eyes, and the way she looked when talking so happily.

[So... it reminded me of a long time ago. You know, it was like that in the 1,864th turn too. Right?]

"Yes?"

Listening absentmindedly, I snapped back to my senses. Up until now, I thought Uriel was talking about the original 'Kim Dokja'.

"Were the words you just said your impressions of watching my story all this time?"

[Of course. What else?]

Uriel had been watching my story since that early on?

[I missed it.]

Whether she knew my thoughts or not, Uriel continued speaking as she looked at me with nostalgic eyes.

[It felt as if I were living through those days once again. For the stars that still cannot leave this story, it felt like you were carrying out the scenarios until only a single reader remains... Was that too sentimental? I'm sorry, when they were all life-or-death scenarios for you...]

I couldn't say anything in response.

After a brief silence, a white light could be seen streaming in from afar. The tunnel was finally coming to an end.

"Uriel."

We looked at each other at the same time. In the faintly brightening light, her face was clearly visible. The emotions that couldn't be seen in the darkness seemed to be exposed in broad daylight. A longing faded by the passage of time. And even a resignation that foretold a certain end.

"It's not over yet."

Perhaps to her, who was once the Archangel of <Eden> and had fought the final battle of that terrible scenario, the conclusion of this worldline was faintly visible.

[Kim Dokja. Do you... really have to take Heewon?]

I thought for a moment, then nodded again and replied,

"Yes. She is my companion."

[What if... Heewon can no longer fight?]

Just as I was about to ask what she meant, the sound of water echoed from somewhere. The scenery shifted at the end of the tunnel, and a vast river unfolded before our eyes.

I could see broken bridge piers below the river. A broken subway train lay scattered on top of the piers. In the center of the river, a giant monster species was floating belly-up.

I recognized what that monster was at a glance.

「Sea Commander.」

Why was this scenery—that monster—in Jung Heewon's inner world? In an instant, a series of thoughts connected like a circuit in my mind.

「Why did Jung Heewon react so strongly to the 'World Snake'?」

Along with a feeling of suffocation in my chest, I was overcome with the sensation of understanding everything.

[I couldn't do it. No matter what I did, I couldn't cross over to that scenery. Heewon wouldn't allow it.]

Listening to Uriel's voice, I stared at the dead Sea Commander. The area near the Sea Commander's belly was glowing white.

[Dokja-ya.]

With just that, I could tell where Jung Heewon's soul was right now.

[Save Heewon.]

I nodded and immediately dove into the Han River.

*

Jung Heewon was dreaming.

「I don't want to wake up.」

Even though she knew she had to wake up from the dream, something was weighing her down. As if dragging her down to a deeper depth, the sentences written upon her were binding her.

「You must not wake up.」

Jung Heewon stared at that sentence.

「You must absolutely not wake up.」

Looking at those sentences, Jung Heewon remembered why she had ended up trapped here. There was no order to her memories, but there were still things that came to mind clearly.

The first thing that came to mind was Yoo Joonghyuk's face, clad in a pitch-black coat.

「"Stop! Get back!"」

And the man in a pure white coat who appeared before her eyes.

「"You arrived sooner than I expected. Is my brother not here yet?"」

The moment she first saw that man, Jung Heewon was deeply shocked. One reason was that the man's appearance resembled the person she had protected all this time, and the other was because she felt goosebumps all over her body the instant she looked at him.

「"You are that person, aren't you?"」

Whether it was appropriate to call that being a 'person' was uncertain, but Jung Heewon could tell instinctively. That the man standing before her eyes was the source of all tragedy.

「"I will stop you."」

Jung Heewon was confident. It didn't matter who the enemy was, even if it was a being that transcended humanity. Just to protect a single person, to reach the end of the story with him, she had honed and polished her sword. That was why she swung her sword without hesitation even at that moment.

A trajectory meant purely for killing, showing no mercy in her moves. The sword strike at the end of that trajectory gracefully grazed the man's cheek. With a rustle, stories dripped down like drops of blood.

「"For some reason, I'm envious. Did you want to protect my brother that much?"」

The man seemed to be surprised by her skill, and also seemed to be saddened.

「"But you cannot stop anything. Nothing at all."」

Jung Heewon swung her sword once more at the smiling man who approached. And in the next moment, as if time had stopped, the man reached out his hand.

「"Aren't you curious?"」

For a moment, Jung Heewon couldn't move. Even though she knew it was the man's authority, she couldn't refuse it. The man's cold fingertips touched Jung Heewon's forehead.

「"What will happen to you at the end of this story. What kind of scenery you will see."」

Like turning the page of a book, his cold finger swept her bangs.

「"See it for yourself. The result of your hard work."」

And the destined future unfolded before Jung Heewon's eyes. Scenery where people died, stars fell, and the <Star Stream> finally met its end.

Jung Heewon laughed. She already knew. She knew that such a cruel tragedy would occur at the conclusion of all these worlds, and that it wouldn't simply be a happy ending. So she tried to say that she wasn't afraid of something like this.

At least, until she saw the scene that unfolded in the next moment.

「Jung Heewon blankly stared down at the blood on her hands.」

The moment she read that sentence, Jung Heewon's heart beat strangely. Perhaps it was an ordinary sentence. Looking down at her blood-stained hands was something she had already done hundreds, thousands of times.

「Her sword was piercing through someone's chest. Following the tilt of the blade, stories flowed and scattered beautifully.」

Yet the moment she read the next sentence, she felt strangely afraid of reading what came next. Even so, she couldn't help but read. Because someone's stories flowing along the surface of the sword were so warm and gentle. Because those stories were so familiar—

[You have learned your '■■'!]

Jung Heewon had no choice but to confirm who she had pierced.

「Incarnation Jung Heewon will kill the being she wanted to protect the most.」

Kim Dokja, pierced by her sword, was slowly collapsing onto the ground.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1037 Episode 63. Ragnarok (11)

"No."

The words she muttered without realizing it held her true feelings.

"No! No!"

Watching Kim Dokja vomit blood, Jung Heewon began to struggle frantically. Before her eyes, Kim Dokja was dying in real-time.

"It is useless to resist."

Snowfield Kim Dokja said with a smile.

"Because this record cannot be changed."

Jung Heewon shook her head violently.

There was no way.

She would kill Kim Dokja?

Of all people, she—would kill him? Why?

It made no sense. It was impossible.

Nevertheless, all of her senses were telling her that the words of that existence were not wrong. That [Fate] would surely be executed.

Rage against herself and a sense of helplessness washed over her at the same time.

[Your soul is violently shaking!]

If this was the future she faced as a result of her efforts to protect him, why had she been swinging her sword all this time?

[Your story reacts to your madness!]

Amidst her fading consciousness, Yoo Joonghyuk's shout echoed like a memory.

"Jung Heewon!"

She had to answer. She had to escape from here. But her thoughts could not translate into actions.

With that, Jung Heewon realized. She would now never escape the [Fate] she had seen.

"Of course, there is a way to avoid executing fate."

As Snowfield Kim Dokja smiled, Jung Heewon suddenly lifted her head.

"It is to realize fate first before it occurs."

A dazzling white light flowed from Snowfield Kim Dokja's hand.

"It is to imprison that [Fate] inside you forever."

Feeling the pure white light encroaching on her mind, Jung Heewon lost consciousness.

*

Jung Heewon dreamed an endless dream. It was a harsh and terrible dream.

"Heewon-ssi."

In that dream, she killed Kim Dokja. She killed him again and again.

"Heewon-ssi."

The sensation of the sword blade piercing through flesh with a squelch. Every single time, Jung Heewon's hands trembled and she wailed. She did so even though she knew this was a dream. Because she didn't want to kill Kim Dokja, she struggled desperately to avoid killing him.

But no matter what she did, she eventually killed Kim Dokja in the dream. In the dream, that [Fate] was being constantly executed.

At least while having this dream, [Fate] would not become reality. This was the curse that 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' had placed upon her.

Proxy Realization of Fate.

As long as this dream continued, she could avoid killing the 'real Kim Dokja'. By repeatedly executing [Fate] while trapped in the dream forever, she could postpone his actual murder.

Turning away from the dream-world Kim Dokja who spoke to her, Jung Heewon swung her sword time and time again.

"Heewon-ssi."

She didn't want to see his expression.

"Heewon-ssi."

She didn't want to watch him die.

"Heewon-ssi."

The conclusion was always set.

Ten times, twenty times, thirty times.

Jung Heewon killed the dream-world Kim Dokja over and over.

Once Kim Dokja died, the dream rewound to the beginning just like always.

The desolate battlefield of Ragnarok. At the top of a steep hill, there was Kim Dokja standing with his back turned. Jung Heewon walked toward him. To kill the person she wanted to protect more than anyone else.

"Hmm."

It was then that she felt an unexpected, strange presence. It was clearly the exact same scene as before, but something was different.

An intense gaze felt from right beside her.

Almost convulsively, Jung Heewon turned her head. A person was standing there.

"If I had known my 41st turn self would be this pathetic, I wouldn't have lent you my body in the first place."

The moment she heard that voice, Jung Heewon realized who the other person was.

"You are—"

A memory suddenly flashed in her mind.

When she entered the Bush of the Missing, Jung Heewon had possessed the incarnation body of another 'Jung Heewon' who was not herself.

A body that was extremely trained and abnormally strong.

There was no mistake. The 'Jung Heewon' standing before her eyes now was the very same 'Jung Heewon' she had possessed back then.

The 1,864th turn. <Kim Dokja's Company's> Jung Heewon.

With trembling eyes, Jung Heewon looked at the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon. In an instant, hope bloomed in her heart. Jung Heewon knew vaguely what kind of world the 1,864th turn was.

The worldline that had witnessed the 'conclusion' of this hellish scenario.

If it was this 'Jung Heewon', if she helped her, maybe she could escape from this situation. Maybe she could change the destined fate.

"What are you doing? Go kill him."

However, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon had an indifferent expression.

"You're going to do it anyway. Hurry up and go kill him."

Jung Heewon couldn't understand her words. How could she, of all people, speak like that?

"No."

How could she tell her to kill Kim Dokja?

"Proxy Realization of Fate."

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon clicked her tongue as if she already knew the whole situation.

"If you don't kill his illusion here, [Fate] will manifest in reality."

"....."

"Are you going to let that happen? In the end, are you going to just let him die?"

Jung Heewon bit her lip hard.

She actually knew. Jung Heewon knew very well what she had chosen in order to prevent that.

"It was your choice. You chose a life of going mad alone, trapped here and endlessly killing that illusion. A hundred times, a thousand times, ten thousand times. You chose to kill him in your mind."

Jung Heewon shook her head violently. She thought she knew what her choice was. But listening to those words made her doubt.

Do I really know what I chose?

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon continued in a cold voice.

"So go kill him. Kill him again and again. Until that person disappears from your heart, until he is no longer precious to you."

"I don't want to—"

[Fate] was forcibly realized, and her sword moved. Another Kim Dokja died. Feeling a pain as if her heart were being ripped apart, Jung Heewon screamed.

"No! I don't want to!"

The illusion shattered. Time rewound as if a regression had occurred. And once again, the back of Kim Dokja standing on the hill was visible.

Staring at his back together, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon said,

"Then you shouldn't have made such a choice in the first place."

Jung Heewon wanted to say that there was no other way. She wanted to say that this was the only way to prevent the realization of [Fate].

"How do you know whether that [Fate] will manifest or not?"

She couldn't help but know.

If anyone else, not just Jung Heewon, had been in that position, they would have had no choice but to know that 'Snowfield Kim Dokja's' words were the truth.

"And even if such a [Fate] were to manifest, do you think Dokja-ssi would just let it happen?"

Jung Heewon was left speechless. Those words were correct. If Kim Dokja had learned of her [Fate], he would certainly not have left it alone.

But before she could reply, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon spoke again.

"No. That man might actually have left it alone. Because if it's a situation where he can die alone and save you, he is definitely the type of person who would sacrifice his own life."

The Kim Dokja that Jung Heewon knew was indeed like that. A person who would sacrifice himself rather than let anyone else get hurt. That was Kim Dokja. That was why she couldn't speak of the [Fate] she faced.

However, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon's words were not finished yet.

"But the Dokja-ssi I know is at least not someone who would turn everything into a tragedy."

"....."

"No matter how many times he dies and sacrifices himself, he is someone who ultimately struggles to find the correct answer. He's someone who would never imprison his companion in a [Fate] like this."

Jung Heewon had no response. The only thing she could do was accept the scolding from another version of herself from another worldline.

"So you should have trusted him."

Jung Heewon wanted to ask. How did you know Kim Dokja so well?

But instead, she asked something else.

"What..... should I do?"

"What do you mean, what should you do? You already made your choice."

"You said Dokja-ssi might know a way to change fate. Then I, too.....!"

"That's only possible for that crazy human."

"If I go crazy, can I change it?"

Stories began to leak from Jung Heewon's entire body.

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession' continues the storytelling.]

Watching that story, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon muttered in admiration,

"It really is a crazy story."

Watching another Kim Dokja die, Jung Heewon asked again,

"How crazy do I have to be? As crazy as the stars in the sky? Or—"

Suddenly, a man came to mind. A man wearing a pitch-black coat. A human who was stronger than anyone she knew, like a distant wall.

"As crazy as that person named Yoo Joonghyuk?"

"He's pretty crazy in his own right."

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon fell silent as if thinking for a moment. In the meantime, another Kim Dokja died. Time rewound, and Kim Dokja's back appeared in the distance again.

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon said,

"Well..... okay. It's difficult, but not impossible. You don't want to kill that person, right?"

"I want to stop [Fate]."

A ring of chaos momentarily flickered in the eyes of the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon. As if trying to read all the stories woven into this [Fate], her eyes sharply stared at Kim Dokja.

After finishing her thoughts, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon spoke.

"Then first, let's practice killing him painlessly."

"What?"

"You are still too weak to overcome [Fate]."

According to the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon, to overcome [Fate], there was no choice but to become stronger than the existence that bestowed that [Fate].

"It happens to be a good place to grow stronger. Now, swing your sword."

"You want me to kill him again?"

"To avoid killing him, you must kill him."

She couldn't understand what that meant.

After hesitating for a moment, Jung Heewon had no choice but to swing her sword.

"Too slow."

Every time she swung her sword, Kim Dokja died.

"Faster."

Kim Dokja kept dying.

"Look closer. You must watch him die precisely. Don't look away. Look clearly at where you swung your sword and what you cut."

Even though she couldn't understand why she had to do that, Jung Heewon did as she was told. She cut Kim Dokja, and did not take her eyes off the dying Kim Dokja. Even though she felt a heartbreaking sadness every time, she did not look away from what she had done. Like that, she swung her sword and killed Kim Dokja again.

With every swing, Jung Heewon felt herself becoming better and better at killing Kim Dokja. And as she became better at killing him, she felt as if she was also learning how to avoid killing him.

Where Kim Dokja's weak points were. What kind of reaction he showed when surprised. How his breathing and muscle movements worked.

Just to kill him with the minimum amount of pain, Jung Heewon swung her sword even more precisely.

Jung Heewon's sword qi became sharper and, at the same time, thinner. Gradually, her sword qi was approaching formlessness.

After killing Kim Dokja how many more times, Jung Heewon became able to cut him before he could even notice her.

Then, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon gave another instruction.

"From now on, do not swing your sword."

"Are we not killing him?"

"No, you have to kill him. You have no choice."

That was true. Her body was being forcibly dragged by [Fate]. If she could avoid killing him just because she didn't want to, she would have done so long ago.

The only thing she could choose was the method of killing Kim Dokja.

"Without swinging your sword, you must be able to cut him solely with the thought that you have swung it."

For a moment, Jung Heewon wondered what on earth that meant.

"Your will becomes the blade."

Suddenly, a story she had once heard from the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint came to Jung Heewon's mind.

"It is a realm that Transcendents call the 'Mind Sword'."

The Mind Sword.

A sword strike that materializes one's own will.

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon said,

"If you can cut your opponent with only your will, you can give them the sensation of being 'cut' without actually harming them. A Mind Sword that has reached a certain level can kill the opponent without actually killing them."

She vaguely understood what that meant.

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon quietly stared at the 41st turn's Jung Heewon who was listening intently, and then slowly drew her sword.

"And a Transcendent who has trained that Mind Sword to the absolute limit—"

Her beautiful sword strike moved as if cutting an invisible thread in the empty air.

"Can cut their own [Fate] with their sword."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1038 Episode 63. Ragnarok (12)

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A technique that could cut her own [Fate].

For the first time since being trapped in this illusion, Jung Heewon's heart beat.

"Can you use the Mind Sword too?"

"I can't."

"What?"

"There are many ways to grow stronger. The Mind Sword wasn't the path I chose."

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon scratched her cheek and added,

"But you are different from me. Since you chose the path of a Transcendent, reaching the Mind Sword will be an effective way to resist [Fate]."

She understood what she meant. Honestly, from Jung Heewon's perspective, it didn't really matter how she grew stronger. What mattered was the result of that method.

"If I learn the Mind Sword."

Jung Heewon looked down at her sword, which was moving to kill Kim Dokja, and asked,

"Can I become stronger than Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Was it an unexpected question?

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon widened her eyes slightly, then let out a smirk.

"I know what you're thinking, but even if you work yourself to death, the current you cannot catch up to Joonghyuk-ssi."

"I guess that means you couldn't catch up to him either."

"What are you talking about? You and I are different."

To the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon, who replied with a twitch of her lips, Jung Heewon urged,

"How did you become strong? How can I become as strong as you?"

"You just have to wager everything you have."

"I'm already doing that."

"You don't know what you have."

A pattern of chaos floated in the eyes of the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon.

"You still don't know what it means to fight wagering all of your stories."

Even the same words carry different weight depending on who says them.

Hearing the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon say that, Jung Heewon felt like she was truly someone who knew nothing.

"In that sense, this place is a stroke of luck for you. Because here, there's a slight chance you might catch up to Joonghyuk-ssi."

"A stroke of luck? In a place like this?"

"Everything in this world is ultimately made of stories. When do you think a story grows stronger?"

She had never thought about such a thing.

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon spoke as if she expected that.

"It's when you lose something precious."

It was incomprehensible. If you lose something precious, a story grows stronger?

"More precisely, it's when you do not collapse despite having lost something precious."

Only then did Jung Heewon understand a bit why the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon had said 'you cannot catch up to Yoo Joonghyuk.'

Through countless regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk had endured a distant sorrow.

In those regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk must have collapsed and stood back up time and time again. That was why his stories were boundlessly solid.

"Is that why you called it a stroke of luck?"

And right now, in a sense, Jung Heewon was experiencing a regression of 'repeatedly losing' her most precious person. Even though it was an illusion, every time she killed Kim Dokja, her heart endured a deep and vivid sorrow.

"Yes. As long as you don't grow numb or collapse."

Jung Heewon nodded.

"You look quite confident."

To not grow numb, and to not collapse.

"Because there's no way I could ever get used to losing him."

Jung Heewon said so and unleashed the Formless Sword Qi. She cut Kim Dokja again and again. Sorrow washed over her every time. Each time a Kim Dokja died, a series of moments she had spent with him came to mind.

Strangely, tears began to fall. Even though she was someone who rarely cried, tears kept welling up.

Watching her, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon asked,

"Aren't you grieving too much?"

"You told me not to grow numb."

"No, it's just... it seems different from the grief of losing a companion."

Jung Heewon did not answer.

How she interpreted that silence was unclear, but the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon quietly shook her head.

"There's no way."

"What about you?"

"Me? What do you mean?"

"I've read your story before."

The first time Jung Heewon read the story of the 1,864th turn was on the rooftop of the Theater Dungeon.

There, she had met the 1,864th turn's Han Sooyoung, and learned a bit about what kind of life her 1,864th turn self had lived.

"You."

Just like her self in this worldline, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon also had her own Kim Dokja.

"Did you protect him well until the end?"

The answer did not return for a long time. In the meantime, one Kim Dokja, then two Kim Dokjas died. Finally, around the time the third Kim Dokja lost his life, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon spoke.

"I tried."

She tried.

"I tried, and tried again. To the point where I wanted to die, to the point where I felt it would be fine if my breath stopped while training like this."

From the breath mixed between her answers, a heavy regret and despair could be felt.

"But I couldn't protect him."

Jung Heewon turned her head to look at the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon. Perhaps her 1,864th turn self had also felt the same emotions as her.

"Why did you try to protect him to that extent?"

"That's....."

"Did you love him?"

At Jung Heewon's question, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon paused. Then she smirked.

"If anyone else had asked that question, I would have been angry. You don't use those words between family."

"Family?"

"But since it was you who asked, I'll answer honestly."

The gazes of the two Jung Heewons met. In that moment when she could perhaps only be honest to herself, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon finally spoke her true feelings.

"I loved him."

Hearing the answer, Jung Heewon paused. It was because she understood that the word 'love' coming from her mouth was not just love in a common and ordinary sense.

"I still love him."

Some emotions can only be explained that way. Because there is no stronger expression, one has no choice but to use the word love. Yet it was by no means an emotion toward a lover. Perhaps an emotion deeper and encompassing far more.

"That's why I came all the way here too. To protect the person I want to protect in this cursed world."

It was the heart that truly cherished an existence.

Jung Heewon understood that heart. That was why she too could speak with all her heart.

"I want to protect him too."

"Then become strong."

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon said. She continued in a voice smoldering with deep anger,

"Become so strong that no star, no scenario, and no [Fate] can block your sword."

Could an existence become that strong? Jung Heewon still did not know. Because she did not know, she had to train.

"To do that, do not draw your sword from now on. Kill that person without drawing your sword."

Jung Heewon followed that advice. But even if she didn't draw her sword, [Fate] moved her.

「Incarnation Jung Heewon will kill the being she wanted to protect the most.」

Because that was the only sentence ruling this world right now.

Tsu-chuchuchuchut.

In the end, her drawn sword cut Kim Dokja. But Jung Heewon did not lose her patience.

"Cut him with only your will. You can do it without drawing your sword."

Of course, it didn't go well. Regardless of her will, the sword was drawn every time and Kim Dokja died.

Yet clearly, Jung Heewon was advancing little by little.

As proof, the execution forced by [Fate] was being delayed bit by bit. Perhaps fate had also read her murderous intent to kill Kim Dokja.

"I can do it. A little more."

Her sword, which was drawn in 10 seconds at first, was drawn in 20 seconds at some point, and then in 30 seconds.

"Hold on a bit more."

It passed 1 minute. Then 2 minutes, 3 minutes, 5 minutes.

"Stronger, forge your will into murderous intent, and mold that intent into a blade."

Countless Kim Dokjas died. Facing the rushing sorrow head-on, Jung Heewon continued to postpone the time.

10 minutes, 20 minutes, 30 minutes.

1 hour. And—one day.

For an entire day, Jung Heewon succeeded in not cutting Kim Dokja.

Soon, one day became two, then three, then four.

Cold sweat pouring from her entire body, Jung Heewon continued to refine her murderous intent.

「A murderous intent that even deceives [Fate].」

From then on, time began to accelerate strangely. It was impossible to tell how much time had passed. Perhaps more than a month had gone by.

After cutting, cutting, and cutting countless Kim Dokjas, Jung Heewon realized that she had reached a certain realm.

In the far distance, there was Kim Dokja. And there was herself watching him. Holding the hilt, she did not draw her sword.

She only thought,

「I cut Kim Dokja.」

The moment she thought so, a scar appeared on Kim Dokja's back in the distance. Watching Kim Dokja slowly collapse, Jung Heewon exhaled.

Watching that from beginning to end, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon said,

"You did it."

The Mind Sword. She had finally ascended to the supreme realm spoken of by Transcendents.

Tsu-chuchuchut.

And an abnormal phenomenon occurred.

An 'event' that had never occurred before was about to be recorded in this world.

"Heewon-ssi."

Kim Dokja, who should have definitely been showing his back, was slowly turning around to face her.

With a stiffened expression, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon said,

"[Fate] has noticed your power."

Kim Dokja approached. He was getting closer step by step.

"It has realized that you threaten it."

「Incarnation Jung Heewon will kill the being she wanted to protect the most.」

Jung Heewon stared directly at that record. Mobilizing all the will she possessed, she directed her murderous intent toward that sentence.

Kim Dokja kept approaching. And finally, when he reached a distance of three steps.

「I cut fate.」

The moment she activated the Mind Sword, Jung Heewon realized.

「Right now, [Fate] was wearing the appearance of 'Kim Dokja'.」

And the Kim Dokja in that illusion was entirely a Kim Dokja she had created. The Kim Dokja she knew. The Kim Dokja she cherished. The Kim Dokja she wanted to protect more than anyone.

「What will happen if I cut that Kim Dokja?」

Jung Heewon knew the answer. The moment she cut him, the concept of 'Kim Dokja' would disappear from within her. She would forget Kim Dokja. She would lose the subject she wanted to protect more than anyone forever.

With that, [Fate] would exhaust its effect.

「[Fate] will eventually be destroyed by realizing itself.」

Jung Heewon trembled.

Her struggle to cut [Fate] was, above all, a process to execute [Fate] precisely.

At the very, very end, Jung Heewon ultimately despaired.

「She cannot kill Kim Dokja.」

Because it could not be overcome, it was truly [Fate]. Jung Heewon asked, shedding tears of blood,

"You..... knew from the start that it wouldn't work, didn't you?"

Watching her from the side, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon slowly nodded and replied,

"Yeah."

"Then why did you make me do this?"

"Because you had to become strong."

"Because I hoped that at least the you here would become strong enough to protect him."

"I became strong! But if I still can't cut fate despite becoming strong, what was the point of all this!"

The 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon smiled faintly and looked up at the sky.

"Did you know? No matter how much humans try, they cannot save each other."

As if there were an invisible star beyond that sky, she slowly reached out her hand.

"The only ones who can be saved are those who have the courage to reach out their hand. Even if what touches their fingertips is a blade, those who can ask to be saved toward that blade's tip. Those who have the courage to grab the opponent's blade's tip and rise again while bleeding."

Jung Heewon couldn't understand those words.

As if it were only natural that she couldn't understand them yet, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon smiled and said,

"Look closely at the person in front of you. He keeps calling you."

Blinking very slowly, Jung Heewon looked at the Kim Dokja in front of her. Then, Kim Dokja called her.

"Heewon-ssi."

It was a voice she had certainly heard countless times. Yet for some reason, at that moment, it sounded different.

"Ah."

Only then did Jung Heewon realize.

「The 'sentence of fate' that had forced her was already gone.」

The one in front of her now was not the Kim Dokja she had created.

This Kim Dokja was—

"Heewon-ssi."

Just since when had it been? How long had he been calling her?

"I'm here."

Listening to Kim Dokja's voice, Jung Heewon felt like she was about to collapse.

In that moment, a pale, long hand approached before her eyes. Jung Heewon blankly stared at the hand, then grabbed it tightly. Strangely, the moment she held it, Jung Heewon felt a sensation as if the deepest part of her heart was being cut.

"Let's return together."

With beams of light, the scenery began to scatter. Watching the space of [Fate] disappear, Jung Heewon hurriedly turned around.

She wanted to ask. If she could really do it. If she could protect the person she wanted to protect this time.

But when she looked back, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon was no longer there.

「Now the real [Fate] will come to find her.」

Within the scattering light, the 1,864th turn's Jung Heewon's voice echoed.

—Don't worry. If you can't do it, no one in any worldline can.

Jung Heewon decided to believe her words.

「And so, at last, all the Kings of the 'Hall' had gathered.」

She took another step forward along with her [Fate].

It was finally time to open the last 'door'.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1039 Episode 63. Ragnarok (13)

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Jung Heewon did not wake up immediately. Having escaped her inner world first, I laid the collapsed Jung Heewon down for a moment and then checked the stories of my entire body. Fortunately, there did not seem to be any major issues with my stories.

Just in time, the Handsome Monkey King, who found me waking up, asked with a brightened expression,

[Oh, you're already awake?]

The Handsome Monkey King looked back and forth between the collapsed Jung Heewon and me, then asked with an expression that seemed to struggle to hide his shock,

[Did you really defeat the 'Mad Emperor'?]

"She just fainted. I didn't really do anything."

In reality, there was nothing I did inside Jung Heewon. She shattered the illusion with her own strength, and all I did was reach out my hand to her. Even without me, she would have fully overcome her trial.

[The constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', admires your activity!]

Uriel also seemed to be greatly delighted by Jung Heewon's safe return. I nodded toward the empty air as a greeting of gratitude. Watching that, the Handsome Monkey King narrowed his eyes and asked,

[Are you also acquainted with that crazy archangel?]

"Uriel isn't crazy."

[Until now, it was hard to even approach because that crazy angel kept wrapping around and protecting the Mad Emperor. I thought it was just a good match of crazy ones.]

"Heewon-ssi isn't crazy either."

[Can you still say that after seeing that story?]

As if responding to his words, Jung Heewon's story wound around my fingertips.

[The story, 'Regret, Devastation, Obsession' is delighted by your reunion!]

I smiled and untangled the story wrapped around my finger.

"Doesn't everyone have one or two crazy stories anyway?"

It was only after about ten minutes had passed that Jung Heewon regained consciousness.

"Heewon-ssi, are you awake?"

After waking up, Jung Heewon just shed tears while looking at me for a while. She grabbed both of my cheeks tightly as if to check something, and let out choking breaths.

"Dokja-ssi, are you okay? Since when, since when were you there?"

"I'm okay."

"Didn't it hurt? I'm so sorry. Really..."

I shrugged and replied,

"It was all an illusion anyway."

I recalled when I first entered the 'ichthyosaur' where Jung Heewon was sleeping. Honestly, I was flustered at first. Because as soon as I entered, Jung Heewon threw her sword at me without hesitation.

"It's okay since I didn't die."

To tell the truth, it did hurt. There was no way it wouldn't. But I had the [Fourth Wall], and I was relatively used to pain compared to others. I knew Jung Heewon was growing stronger by cutting me, so I didn't want to interfere with her growth.

"Still, don't ever do that again. Never."

"I understand."

Only after getting repeated promises from me did Jung Heewon let out a deep sigh and relax.

I was able to hear various stories from Jung Heewon about what had happened in the meantime. How she left the 'Bush of the Missing' after separating from me and participated in the 'main battlefield' with Yoo Joonghyuk. How she was chased by the army of catastrophes as soon as she entered the battlefield. And how she encountered 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' while fighting at the front line.

Up to that point, it was a story I had roughly anticipated.

Since Jung Heewon's life had been confirmed, I decided to ask everything I was curious about this time.

"What happened to Ji Eunyu-ssi? And the other companions?"

Jung Heewon slowly shook her head. Unfortunately, because she encountered 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' as soon as she joined the 'main battlefield', she didn't seem to have heard their news properly.

"Did you see <Kim Dokja's Company>?"

"<Kim Dokja's Company>?"

"The ones who came from the 1,864th turn..."

According to Ji Eunyu's information, Snowfield Kim Dokja had definitely clashed with <Kim Dokja's Company>.

"Ah."

Fortunately, Jung Heewon seemed to know about them.

"They are..."

As she spoke, Jung Heewon suddenly frowned and stumbled. The moment I hurriedly supported her, I felt a strong noise embedded in her story. The cause was clear.

「Her memories have been sealed.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja had locked her memories. Why? Was there a reason I shouldn't read her memories?

"Heewon-ssi, are you okay?"

Jung Heewon's shoulders trembled faintly. Just by trying to recall the unclear memory, she seemed to feel a deep dread. Although she had only briefly seen 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', a deep fear of him was deeply engraved in her mind. It was perhaps natural. Because of him, she had been trapped in an illusion for a vast amount of time, killing me again and again.

"Actually, I'm not okay."

"Yes. I know."

"No. Dokja-ssi doesn't know."

She was someone who had mastered the Formless Sword Qi and could now even handle the Mind Sword. Even though she had reached a realm that would earn the respect of many Transcendents, her voice was filled with complete discouragement.

"Honestly, I don't feel like we can win against that existence at all."

"We can win."

At my confident words, Jung Heewon suddenly lifted her head. I gently wrapped my hands around her shoulders and continued speaking.

"If that bastard was truly strong, he wouldn't have done this to Heewon-ssi in the first place."

I had already heard about 'Snowfield Kim Dokja's' strength. For example, the story of how he exercised the authority of the 'Oldest Dream' to shoot down half of the constellations that descended on the 'main battlefield'. It was indeed a shocking power, but in fact, I didn't fully believe that story.

「He hasn't become the 'Oldest Dream' yet.」

There was no way the current him could perform such miracles. The probability of the <Star Stream> wouldn't allow it either. If such a thing really happened, it must have been because he used some special method.

"He judged that Heewon-ssi would be an obstacle to his conclusion. In other words, Heewon-ssi is an important force that is threatening even to him."

Perhaps Snowfield Kim Dokja had some constraint that prevented him from killing the 41st turn's Jung Heewon. Still, he must have known very well that simply leaving her alive would interfere with his conclusion.

"But Heewon-ssi has eventually woken up, and now we can win. Look, we already have a stellar lineup gathered."

Before we knew it, the other 'Kings' were standing behind us: the Handsome Monkey King, the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, and the Mass Production Maker.

Jung Heewon muttered as if in sigh,

"You've persuaded them all."

"Yes. Lastly, I need Heewon-ssi's help."

"Help."

Jung Heewon repeated my words blankly. I nodded at her and said,

"Yes. Please go with me to the main battlefield. Of course, if you don't want to, you may refuse."

Every time I made an shameless request, I felt like a heavy weight was hanging in my heart. Someone might ask what the point of asking was when I knew she wouldn't refuse. Nevertheless, I had to ask every time. To let her know, or to let myself know, that such requests could be refused at any time—I had to keep asking.

A relationship of trust is like that. Not binding the other person with one's own will. Even if you trust them and know their heart, checking and confirming that heart once again.

"You know my answer."

"Still, I want to ask."

I thought that this time, her answer might be different. Because I didn't know the pain she had gone through, or the fear she felt toward my brother.

"Let's go together."

Nevertheless, I knew she would answer that way.

"Thank you."

Because Jung Heewon was that kind of person. Because she was someone who would not bend her beliefs no matter what. I firmly believed that only such a person could witness the final conclusion.

[Will we depart immediately? The preparations are complete.]

As if the waiting had been long enough, the Mass Production Maker urged. We immediately stepped out of Orochi. We planned to go straight to where the 'door' was by ship.

But what was this? Near the ship parked in the distance, there was a crowd gathered.

「Someone was surrounding the Mass Production Maker's warship.」

Even at a glance, there were hundreds of constellations. There were familiar faces, and some who were not.

The Mass Production Maker clicked his tongue and muttered,

[Oh, they are the residents.]

Residents? Finding them, Jung Heewon responded,

"They are the people who lived inside my territory."

I belatedly recalled the existences that had hidden in the mud huts. The Mass Production Maker added in a pitying tone,

[They are the ones who luckily escaped the 'main battlefield' or survived the 'giant battlefield'.]

Having heard the explanation, I now understood why their faces looked familiar.

Just in time, perhaps finding us, one of the crowd surrounding the warship stepped forward and shouted,

[You guys! You're planning to open the 'door', right?]

I wondered if they wanted to go with us, but looking at their expressions, they were completely terrified. I felt like I knew what purpose they had gathered for.

[We cannot let you do that!]

[You cannot go! You must not open that door!]

[How dare you touch that door...]

[Kings! Are you in your right minds? Don't you all know what will happen if we open the 'door' now!]

Along with the voices pouring out at once, the dark sky of the 'Hall' began to shine brightly. Those stars had gathered to stop us from opening the door to the 'main battlefield'. Seeing the sky filled with constellations that had been hiding until now made me feel strange. The night sky of the <Star Stream>, which had been so dark when I needed help, was shining so brightly just to block me.

The Mass Production Maker spoke gently,

[We aren't asking you to come with us, so please step aside.]

[We cannot do that!]

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon yawned lazily, and the Handsome Monkey King picked his ear as if bored. Jung Heewon and the Mass Production Maker glanced at me without adding any more words. They were probably leaving the choice to me.

I slowly spoke,

"No matter what you say, the 'door' will eventually open. Don't waste your time and step aside."

If necessary, I could have opened the way with [Incite] or swept them all away with a story, but I deliberately did not do so. Perhaps it was the last bit of pity remaining in me.

However, there was one star that trampled on that pity.

[I knew you would react that way.]

I recognized the face of the constellation who stepped forward as he said that.

[It has been a long time, Demon King of Salvation. Do you remember me?]

I stared at his face, which was covered with a double eye patch, and was newly amazed. My god, that constellation was still alive?

「King Oedipus.」

'The one who stabbed his own eyes' - King Oedipus. The star who had hindered me at the 'Recycling Center' and a historical-grade constellation of <Olympus> was here.

[Please give up on the 'door'. If you open that door, all the constellations here will die.]

"I'm sorry, but the door must be opened."

[If you persist, we have no choice but to use strong measures.]

I let out a smirk.

"Strong measures?"

Sensing the status boiling from my entire body, King Oedipus stumbled back. It was inevitable. I now possessed power comparable to a Myth-grade constellation, while he was merely a historical-grade constellation.

He quickly bowed his head with a servile expression and shouted,

[G-Great existence! I know your strength very well! But we have no choice this time. If you open that 'door', everything is finished. Everyone here will die!]

As if he couldn't back down even with such a gap in status, King Oedipus continued his true voice while trembling.

[I heard... you cherish your companions very much.]

As King Oedipus gestured lightly, someone was seen being dragged from behind him. An ominous premonition struck me in an instant.

[So please show mercy and do not open the door.]

King Oedipus pointed his sword at the existence kneeling behind him and said,

[Please, value your companion this time as well.]

In an instant, my blood felt like it was running cold. Because the person Oedipus was pointing at was someone I also knew very well.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1040 Episode 63. Ragnarok (14)

Jung Heewon's face turned pale as she immediately recognized who was taken hostage.

"It's Master Samyeong."

I did not hesitate to pull out 'Unbroken Faith'.

「Master Samyeong was still alive.」

I still remembered his last moments. He took Mitra's blow on our behalf and sent my companions and me to the 'Bush of the Missing'. How could I forget his sacrifice?

[Stop. The moment you draw that sword, this constellation dies.]

King Oedipus had an expression that showed he had nothing to lose anyway. It was the bravado of someone who thought dying by my hand here or dying because the 'door' opened was all the same.

In any case, I didn't need to use a sword. I had a tongue faster than any blade. But just as I was about to raise my status and use [Incite] without him noticing, someone stepped forward before me. It was Jung Heewon.

"Putting you in my 'territory' was out of consideration for the 'Eight-Headed Lord'."

A cold chill emanated from her entire body, and her tone had changed.

"Yamata-no-Orochi, who died by my hand, wanted you to live. That is why I left you alone even when you invaded my territory as you pleased."

At Jung Heewon's words, I felt as if the residual thoughts of Orochi were growling somewhere. The king's status flowing from her entire body. Only then did I personally realize the fact that Jung Heewon was one of the four kings of this 'Hall'.

"But fulfilling his request ends today."

[The constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', vomits anger!]

Witnessing even the archangel's halo rising behind Jung Heewon, King Oedipus hurriedly shouted,

[W-Wait. Stop, Mad Emperor! This is not something you should interfere in—!]

Oedipus's head flew off. A strike that left no time to even scream. Seeing King Oedipus's severed head roll helplessly on the floor, the surrounding constellations shrieked in horror.

[What—]

Almost simultaneously, the heads of the dozen or so constellations surrounding Master Samyeong also disappeared. As if seeking to completely block even resurrection using attributes or stigmata, the incarnation bodies of the constellations whose heads were blown off were cut by dozens of sword qi and torn to pieces.

「Mind Sword.」

Jung Heewon's murderous intent, which had reached the supreme realm, had become a blade and brutally slaughtered the incarnation bodies of the constellations.

[Argh, aah, aaaah!]

As the constellations, including King Oedipus, lost their lives in a single strike, the remaining constellations belatedly regained their senses, screamed, and retreated.

Jung Heewon and I did not miss that gap and ran toward the collapsed Master Samyeong. Checking Master Samyeong's condition up close, it was far more serious than I had

thought.

"Master Samyeong."

His entire body's stories were almost completely shattered. The star of the Korean Peninsula was barely breathing his last breath, looking like it was a miracle he was even alive.

[The constellation, 'Bald General of Justice', is looking at you.]

The starlight that had observed me for a long time was there. An incarnation body damaged beyond repair, where asking if he was okay was already meaningless. Sadly, this was the only thing I could say to the star facing death.

"Master, it's okay now."

I quietly held his crumbling hand. I wanted to sweep away all the stars before my eyes right this instant. Without leaving a single one, I wanted to empty the sky of this 'Hall'.

Then, Master Samyeong spoke.

[Successor.]

The last true voice of the star that had gathered all its stories.

[Please forgive them.]

For a moment, I couldn't understand his words.

[They are merely terrified.]

It was those very stars that had put him in this state.

[Please give them a chance for the last 'story'.]

With those words as his last, all of Master Samyeong's stories scattered. I looked down at the empty ground where he had disappeared. A raw emotion that could hardly be refined was surging inside me.

[Aaaah—]

[Run away! Run!]

Sensing the ominous momentum from me, the constellations hovering nearby turned around and began to flee in a hurry.

I released a true voice.

[Stop.]

Before the true voice imbued with a powerful [Incite], all the constellations in the area froze in place.

[You cannot go anywhere.]

Faced with a Myth-grade status and rendered powerless, the constellations were like children. Some burst into tears, while others closed their eyes as if foreseeing their end.

Of course, not everyone was like that. While some stars tried to appear calm because they hadn't run away from the start, others shouted back at me, placing the blame on me instead.

[D-Didn't he ask you to forgive them!]

[Are you going to ignore the wishes of the Bald General of Justice!]

I spoke to those stars.

[I know who you are. Stars of 'Valhalla Hall'.]

I continued speaking, engraving the faces of each of the bastards who spewed shameless true voices into my eyes.

[You haven't forgotten the 'debt' you owe me, right?]

Looking at each other with faces wondering what that meant, the expressions of the stars rapidly stiffened. Most of them were constellations who had bet D-Coins on 'my defeat' in the final wager of 'Valhalla Hall'. Among them, there were those who had invested in the wager by taking out unreasonable loans. In the end, they lost the bet, and as a result, incurred massive debt.

[We do not owe you a debt! The one we owe is—]

[Yes, the Golden Dice Hall.]

I pulled a shining die from my chest.

「Mitra's Fate Die.」

The star relic entrusted to me by Mitra, the former chairman of 'Valhalla Hall' and the owner of the 'Golden Dice Hall'. Recognizing the die, the stars let out groans of grief.

[Ah, aah...!]

At that time, by winning the wager, I had lent 10 million D-Coins to the 'Golden Dice Hall'. And the debt that the 'Golden Dice Hall' owed me was also the debt that those constellations who lost the bet had to pay.

[The star relic, 'Fate Die', proves its qualification!]

[From now on, you act as the agent of the 'Golden Dice Hall'.]

[You can collect from the stars on behalf of the 'Golden Dice Hall'.]

The values of the stars' stories and their star relics were rising before my eyes in real-time.

[I will collect that debt now.]

Realizing what that meant, the stars trembled.

「Story Collection.」

An authority that the 'Golden Dice Hall' could exercise against stars that failed to pay their debts on time.

[Please! Please—!]

The stories of all the stars who owed a debt to the 'Golden Dice Hall' were scattering bit by bit, turning into D-Coins.

[Save me! Please save us! I don't want to die like this!]

Watching the stars cry miserably, I didn't feel much sympathy. They must have heard the same words from countless incarnations. But how many of them had actually saved the incarnations who begged for their lives?

Nevertheless, looking around at those stars, I suppressed the rising hatred and continued speaking.

[If you go with me to the 'main battlefield', you do not have to pay the debt you owe me.]

At my words, the constellations raised their heads one by one and stared at me blankly.

[If you still have courage left, if you have the will to check the record of the <Star Stream> one last time.]

Actually, I didn't expect much as I spoke. These were stars that had hidden here because they feared the end. I thought cowardice that believed dying on the 'main battlefield' or dying here was all the same wouldn't change with just a word or two of mine.

「This was out of courtesy for Master Samyeong, who had helped me.」

Indeed, after I finished speaking, the stars fell into silence. As expected, no star stepped forward to volunteer. Just as I was thinking that resuming the 'collection' was the only way, someone's true voice was heard.

[Are you serious? Are you really going to give those stars a chance?]

He was not someone who owed a debt to the 'Golden Dice Hall'. But I knew who he was. Because he was a constellation I had once met and fought to the death in the 'New Murim Earth'.

[The constellation, 'Purifying Flame', is looking at you.]

The Purifying Flame 'Agni'. One of the Lokapala of the great <Vedas>, he was also hiding here. However, perhaps because he had suffered a fatal wound on the 'main battlefield', his incarnation body was almost half-destroyed, and his revealed status was not what it used to be.

I looked at him and said,

[Yes. I will give you a chance.]

At my answer, Agni seemed genuinely shaken. He fell silent for a moment as if measuring my sincerity, then spoke in a voice laced with a bit of wonder.

[Do you believe you can change the conclusion of the world by gathering stars that can no longer illuminate anything? You are truly foolish...]

Agni bit his lips several times, then continued as if chewing his words,

[Every nebula has given up. <Olympus>, <Vedas>, <Papyrus>. Yet you, who are just alone, still believe that the 'conclusion' of the world can change even in the face of this end.]

Agni was a star who had once received a fragment of the 'Snowfield'. Since he would know his strength better than anyone, I could understand the despair he suffered. But in the next moment, he uttered unbelievable words.

[If it's alright... I would also like to accompany you on that path.]

Honestly, it was unexpected. I never imagined that he, who had been an enemy until now, would step forward to help me.

[Surya is fighting on the 'main battlefield'.]

I recalled how Surya had rescued Agni in the 'New Murim Earth'. Perhaps Agni wanted to repay the favor from back then.

As Agni declared his join, another constellation stepped forward.

[I will go too.]

He was also a star I knew.

[The constellation, 'Brash Swamp Predator', is looking at you.]

He was a story-grade constellation of the 'Gourmet Association'. Although he had no particular connection with me, he was a star that had a slight relationship with the original Kim Dokja. He glanced at Agni and me with somewhat indifferent eyes, then spat out a rough true voice.

[All contact with other constellations has been cut. Even the Myth-grade constellations of the Absolute Evil system have completely hidden their presence. The meaning of that fact must be clear. I want to confirm their end with my own eyes.]

And so, regardless of good and evil, the stars began to join. Watching the stars declare their participation one by one, only then did I understand why Master Samyeong had asked me to forgive them. Perhaps he thought my forgiveness could become the last spark of this world.

[Is it true... that we don't have to pay the debt if we go with you?]

And for the first time, one of the constellations who owed me a 'debt' asked. It was not a constellation I knew. I quietly looked at his tattered incarnation body and slowly nodded.

[Yes.]

They were stars that already had nothing left but a handful of starlight. But even a handful of starlight can illuminate the darkness. Perhaps what I needed right now was such a small probability.

[I-I will go too. I will go.]

[Is it really... alright to do so?]

The stars, which were few at first, began to multiply. Stars that had sat down in the face of the predestined destruction. The final embers were rising in their eyes.

[I will go too. If you permit it. If we are really allowed to see that conclusion!]

Of course, not every star was like that. As if throwing cold water on the burning atmosphere, an old star shouted,

[Foolish bastards! You don't know what is inside that door!]

The constellation, who was dripping stories from his mouth, kept muttering like gibberish,

[Hehe, hehehe! You will die horribly! You will see a conclusion far more wretched than being collected here! You...]

As I lightly waved my hand, his stories turned into D-Coins and were collected by me.

[If anyone else wants to be collected, keep talking.]

I had no tolerance to bestow upon a star that had collapsed in fear of the next scenario. Nevertheless, perhaps because of the curse of the dead star, a brief silence descended on the area. One of the contemplating constellations slowly spoke.

[Actually, we know that what he just said is right. Even if we go up to the next scenario holding onto hope like this, what awaits us is only a horrible end.]

The constellation who had bowed his head in grief suddenly raised his head and asked,

[Even so, do you want to show us, of all people, the 'next story'?]

[You must find the story you want to see yourselves.]

I had no intention of passing my hope even to the constellations. The scenarios ahead cannot be navigated unless they shine their own light. I had no intention of becoming a babysitter for lost stars.

[I just made a final proposal. Now, if you dislike it, I will resume the collection. If that is the ■■ you want.]

[W-Wait! We will join too!]

Soon, as all the remaining stars declared they would follow me, the Mass Production Maker, who had been watching from the side, stepped forward.

[Those who are ready, board the warship. And if anyone needs treatment or story repair, let me know. I can perform simple emergency treatment.]

As if to prove his words, butlers descended from the warship and guided the constellations. Watching the constellations board the warship submissively, the Mass Production Maker said with a complex expression,

[As you know, most of those stars won't be of much help to you.]

"Constellations are originally of no help. They've been a hindrance ever since they started going on about sponsor sponsors."

[Then why did you accept them?]

"Nevertheless, without those stars."

I thought of the stars in the sky that had watched my story for a long time, and then of Master Samyeong, and said,

"All stories would not have flowed to this point."

Sensing whatever I thought, the Mass Production Maker also put on a troubled smile.

[It is truly strange. Listening to you, it feels as if all the long years were connected to this very moment.]

After all the constellations boarded the warship, we also boarded. Now, only one procedure remained.

When I took out the key I received from the Mass Production Maker, the Black Flame Dragon, seeing that, also took out his key. Jung Heewon also handed over the key she possessed.

"I didn't know we would actually use this."

Lastly, I looked at the Handsome Monkey King. Because he was the only one who hadn't handed over his key yet.

[I still do not completely trust you.]

He stared at me with displeased eyes for a moment, then added with a pout,

[But you have sufficiently proven your qualifications.]

As the Handsome Monkey King pulled the last key from his chest, all four keys were finally gathered.

The Ape King's Key.

Wealth King's Key.

Dragon King's Key.

Mad Emperor's Key.

The warship, jumping with warp drive, reached the front of the sealed door in an instant. Perhaps because we gathered the four keys, a translucent lock floated before me the moment we reached the door.

The lock had five holes. I inserted the keys one by one matching the holes. However, even after inserting all the keys, one hole remained.

The Mass Production Maker said with a smile,

[The last key is the finger of the one who gathered the 'four keys'.]

I hesitated for a moment. This wouldn't get cut off if I put it in, right? Sensing my thoughts, the Mass Production Maker smiled mischievously.

[Since no one has tried it, I can't guarantee what will happen.]

I put on a bitter smile and slipped my index finger into the lock. Fortunately, my finger was not cut. Soon, with a clatter, the seal of the door began to unlock. The talismans fell off, and the chains made of story metal were unraveled. The Handsome Monkey King's Ruyi Jingu Bang was also retrieved.

「Only those who have stacked five stories can reach the qualification of a star.」

The stories engraved on the door were flowing out.

「Only the star that has proven its qualification shall inherit the records of the great <Star Stream>.」

And the door opened.

[Aaaaah...]

Was it because of the thought of stepping onto the final battlefield once again? Some stars groaned in fear. But the Kings by my side had calm expressions.

I looked back at them with a renewed state of mind.

Jung Heewon, a Transcendent who had attained the realm of the Mind Sword and was an incarnation supported by the archangel of the 1,864th turn—Uriel, who was once a great commander of <Eden>.

The Handsome Monkey King, who did not become the 'Oldest Liberator', but gathered all the stories of his brothers to finally be reborn as a single existence.

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, who could exert status comparable to a 'Myth-grade constellation' if he received the protection of the Recorder.

Lastly, the Mass Production Maker, who could exert probability exceeding story-grade through the power of coins.

The fact itself that I was with them before the final scenario was a miracle to me.

[The seal of the 'door' has been released!]

The door emitting an ominous aura slowly opened, and the Mass Production Maker spoke.

[We will enter.]

The warship accelerated and passed straight through the door. I felt a brief sensation of nausea, and in the next moment, the scenery shifted.

"Is this... the 'main battlefield'?"

We were clearly supposed to have arrived at the 'main battlefield', but something was strange. We were still in the dark space. A sensation of my heart fluttering.

I heard the stars murmuring.

[What, what is that—!]

Someone screamed.

Something was looking this way from the other side of space.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1041 Episode 63. Ragnarok (15)

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With a sensation of hair standing on end, I and the other Kings also turned that way. The first to speak was the Handsome Monkey King.

[Huangdi?]

There were the Myth-grade constellations of <Huangdi>.

Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors. The Myth-grade constellations representing <Huangdi>—five of them were there.

Fuxi.

Shennong.

Nüwa.

Huangdi.

Zhuanxu.

But something was strange. The five constellations, who possessed a distant status, had not descended in their normal incarnation bodies.

[What on earth is that—]

A bizarre spherical shape in which the heads of the five constellations were stuck together like organic matter was slowly rotating, spanning across space like a surrealist sculpture.

In that moment when everyone was lost in thought, the face of the frowning Shennong opened its mouth.

【Eternity】

Next, Fuxi, who was shedding tears of blood, said,

【End】

Nüwa, whose lips were twisted, and Huangdi, whose eyes were rolled back, also spoke.

【Protagonist】

【Record】

The last to speak was Zhuanxu, whose tongue was cut off.

【Baby】

The chorus of the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors began.

【EternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabyEternityEndProtagonistRecordBabybybybybybyby】

The warship's defense system was activated. It was a story barrier that blocked all story waves in the area.

[Everyone be careful!]

The moment the Mass Production Maker shouted a warning, a heavy roar echoed throughout the warship. A huge storm of status swept through the area.

Even though the warship's barrier was fully operational, the historical-grade constellations who witnessed the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors rolled their eyes

and fainted on the spot. Most of the constellations who remained awake were also trembling convulsively, venting stories from their entire bodies.

[Ugh... Aaaaah!]

Their souls could not endure just hearing the sorrowful screams of the maddened Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors.

[Three Sovereigns! What happened!]

[Why are the great Myth-grade constellations turned into such monsters!]

I bit my lip hard. It was clear why the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors had ended up in such a state.

"Dokja-ssi."

Jung Heewon spoke in a fearful voice for the first time. It was not a voice of fear toward the monsters that the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors had become. I was also looking at the same place as her. Standing beside that horrible Myth-grade monster was an existence we knew well.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja.」

As if he already knew I was coming, he was looking at me. The mouth of the bastard, on which an ominous smile was hung, slowly opened.

【I.】

My heart beat strangely. It wasn't even this kind of feeling when I saw the deformed Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors. A sensation as if an indescribable gaze of eternity was scanning us. It felt like time had stopped. A chilling sensation spread down my spine. The moment I felt I had to shut his mouth—

【Will no longer read you.】

The sound of a book closing was heard from somewhere. A feeling of something breaking and sliding down. A sensation of all the scenery before my eyes being erased at once. My body creaked and wouldn't move well. I turned around with all my might. Just in time, Jung Heewon was also looking at me.

"Dokja—"

Her figure was gradually fading. It wasn't just Jung Heewon. The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, the Mass Production Maker, the Handsome Monkey King, and all the stars aboard this warship as well.

「Existences that did not receive his gaze were disappearing from the story.」

[Aaaaah□—]

The constellations began to disappear with screams. The scenery slid down, and everything in my field of vision began to turn into blank spaces. As if they had never existed from the start, as if no story remained there anymore—

I looked down at my hands. I could see my hands gradually disappearing. More precisely, the components that made up me, the stories that read me, were scattering.

"Hee□-ssi—"

All the characters are erased, and the scenery where they stood disappears. The darkness, our light, is lost. Soon the stars surrounding us disappear, and the status and individual perish.

「This was the authority of the 'Oldest Dream'.」

Our stories were no longer being read. The number of blank spaces gradually increased, and soon everything became a blank space.

「The universe that he does not read is excluded from the story.」

Yet, even after witnessing such an overwhelming authority, my mind was strangely peaceful.

In the distance, I could see my brother, who was staring at me, slowly turning his head. He did not take his eyes off me and him. I looked into his side, his back. Looking at him, looking at his stories, sensing his authority, looking at that story, I was reading the whole world.

And I recalled.

I I I

Boom!

In an instant, the surrounding scenery flipped.

Tsu-chuchut!

The scattered stories began to return.

Tsu-chuchuchuchut!

「My brother can never erase me.」

As the recording restarted, the stars that had been excluded from the story regained their original light.

「Because the current me was the only 'Kim Dokja' with a status equal to his in this universe.」

The scenery of space returned, and the outer wall of the warship was restored. The constellations collapsed on the floor spat out their held breath.

[Hah, haaaah...!]

Jung Heewon stumbled as if dizzy, and the Mass Production Maker also caught his breath while leaning on his cane.

[Just now, that was...]

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon frowned in anger, and the Handsome Monkey King let out a hollow voice as if reminiscing about the previous wonder.

[Is that... the existence closest to the 'Oldest Dream'.]

As if staring at a mountain of a distant height that he couldn't reach, the Handsome Monkey King asked in a trembling voice,

[Do you really believe you can fight and win against such a thing.]

I stared at my brother in the distance and answered in a calm voice once again.

[We can win.]

As if responding to my answer, messages floated before my eyes.

[The constellation, 'Purifying Flame', sincerely admires your skill.]

[The constellation, 'Brash Swamp Predator', shows strong trust in you.]

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', snorts, saying that you must at least be at that level to be together.]

[The constellation, 'Mass Production Maker', nods meaningfully.]

...

[All constellations on the warship feel an indescribable wonder from you.]

In the distance, 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was seen turning his back and disappearing. The deformed body of the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors also disappeared somewhere following him.

By that, I realized.

「From the beginning, he knew that I would block his authority.」

If so, that must have been his first greeting before the final scenario.

[The recorder of fear, 'Fox Who Rules the Sky', pays respect to your 'reading'.]

[The recorder of fear, 'Demon King of the Cinema', frowns at your 'observation'.]

[The recorder of fear, 'Prince of the Wolves', looks forward to your conclusion.]

...

Sensing the gazes of the recorders waiting for the final record of this world, I stared blankly at the back of my retreating brother.

There were many things I wanted to ask. What happened to <Kim Dokja's Company> who had gone to find him, and what happened to the other readers. What do you hope to achieve by becoming 'the only Kim Dokja' to this extent.

But I did not ask. Because there was not much whitespace left in this world anyway.

「Everything will be known in the conclusion.」

Along with the gravity of the scenario pulling us, the warship began to accelerate again. And finally, the scenery of the 'main battlefield' unfolded before our eyes.

[You have entered the 'main battlefield' of 'Ragnarok'!]

*

In the darkness, Kim Dokja slowly opened his eyes. The place where he opened his eyes was a pure white, ash-colored room. He always fell asleep in this room, and woke up in this room again.

「The room that resembled the landscape of his birth.」

Only in this room could he dream. The dream of reading a universe full of bright stars. The dream of new stars rising and setting. The dream of a wonderful protagonist, and the dream of a man who was not a protagonist becoming a protagonist. And the dream of a single reader who reads all those stories.

Leisurely rising from his seat, Kim Dokja drew the curtains of the window, and the dark sky of the <Star Stream> looked down at him.

Pachuchut.

A small spark. Something dripped from his mouth. A line of story was formed at the corner of his mouth reflected in the window. The excessive use of probability had put a burden on his incarnation body. But Kim Dokja wiped the corner of his mouth as if he didn't care at all and asked,

"You saw it too, right?"

In a tone that made it unclear who he was speaking to, he continued,

"That guy finally came all the way here. He gathered all the fragments and rose to the final scenario."

A somewhat excited monologue echoed in the solitary room. Kim Dokja shook his head as if he didn't hate such silence, then muttered to the air with a bitter smile,

"The stage that you recorded and I created. Han Sooyoung."

As if responding to his words, a small spark momentarily lit up in the air.

「Kim Dokja felt it was funny to see himself talking like a villain. But he had no choice. Because this was the role he had chosen. Just as his father had.」

Kim Dokja smiled quietly.

"Do I look like that?"

「Deceiving himself was the easiest thing for him. Because while reading something, he could always become someone other than himself. Because only by doing so could he endure this world.」

Kim Dokja silently read and read the sentences written for him. While reading those sentences, Kim Dokja could also forget many things. The conclusion of this world, and the cold sorrow that suddenly welled up.

Taking a light breath, Kim Dokja spoke again,

"Soon the final chapter of all stories will begin. Are you ready to write?"

Then, a spark flared in the air once again. Kim Dokja stared at the spark, then spoke again,

"Yes, I haven't forgotten the promise. As long as you write me until the end, I will definitely keep the promise."

Saying that, Kim Dokja slowly closed the curtains. Then, as he lightly flicked his finger, a passage opened on one wall of the white room.

Kim Dokja walked toward the passage. Beyond the elongated oval door, there was a long hallway. It was also a hallway painted in a white close to ash.

Peculiarly, on the sides of the hallway, objects reminiscent of coffins were displayed. On top of the translucent coffins, the names of the individuals inside were written.

Kim Dokja looked at the individuals in the coffins with nostalgic eyes.

「Yoo Sangah.」

「Shin Yoosung.」

「Lee Gilyoung.」

「Lee Seolhwa.」

「Lee Jihye.」

Those names were once called by a single name.

"Kim Dokja Company."

Tsu-chuchut, and a spark flared in the air once again. It was a far more fierce spark than before.

"Don't be so angry. It's just a joke."

Tsu-chuchut.

"Since I was always the only one in a coffin, I just wanted these people to feel the same way at least once."

Inside the translucent coffins, besides the individuals themselves, ash-colored stories were filled and sloshing. Perhaps they were dreaming a deep dream inside those coffins. A sweet dream where no one needed to be buried, and thus there was no reason to grieve over unforeseen losses. Perhaps in that dream, they were living in the big house they wanted so much.

"Please endure it a little."

Kim Dokja looked at those individuals, muttered something softly, and passed the coffins one by one.

Eventually, Kim Dokja's gaze stopped at the last coffin. The moment he looked at the coffin, the individual inside also opened his eyes and glared at him.

「Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Kim Dokja silently received that burning gaze. Enduring the gaze that seemed ready to break the coffin, step out, and cut him down—a gaze containing distant anger and sorrow—Kim Dokja stood there for a long time. And he muttered with a very faint smile,

"Yes, you have the qualification."

Eventually, as Yoo Joonghyuk closed his eyes again, Kim Dokja said in passing,

"...Thank you."

Lastly, he looked back at the white hallway he had walked. On that hallway reminiscent of a snowfield, not a single footprint remained.

「Perhaps there was another conclusion.」

"Do you really think so?"

「Nevertheless, he chose this path.」

Kim Dokja nodded. Now the end of that path was before his eyes. As he walked to the end of the hallway, a hall welcoming him appeared.

【Oh Oh Oh Oh Oh Oh Oh Oh Oh】

With his appearance, the Outer Gods who were wandering around the hall roared.

【O l d e s t D r e a m】

【T h e t i m e t o r e m e m b e r u s h a s c o m e】

【P l e a s e o p e n t h e c o n c l u s i o n o f a l l t h i n g s】

The Outer Gods of the forgotten galaxies, those who were once the terror and tyrants of a world. Existences that were once great stars but had fallen into Outer Gods were also seen. Their stories were erased over long years, and they were howling after even their names were taken away.

Kim Dokja walked on the soft carpet with a smile as if to soothe them. At the end of the carpet was a throne reminiscent of an absolute throne.

The Outer Gods bowed their heads along the path he walked. As he ascended to the closest place to the throne, the deformed body of the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors nearby let out a resentful cry.

Kim Dokja, who lightly stroked the forehead of the deformed body, slowly turned and looked down at the world.

「It took a very long time to get here.」

The stage and characters were all gathered. Now, only one remained. In a voice containing a cold chill, the Snowfield Kim Dokja sitting on the throne said,

"Let's begin the final story."

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[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]

# 1042 Episode 64. Eternal Night (1)

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「"Even so, do you still believe a world where 'stories' exist is right?"」

- Dokkaebi King

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Cha Yerin looked at the boiling black dust cloud in the distance and recalled the day she first came here.

「"Please disappear for a moment."」

It was just a single wave of a hand. With that one gesture, all the history she had lived through was denied. Excluded from the battlefield in an instant, the place she fell was the center of the 'constellation camp'.

「"What? This guy. He's from the 'Disaster' side, isn't he?"」

She became a prisoner of the 'constellation camp'. That was already two months ago. During those two months, so many things had happened. Countless stars had fallen, and as the sky of the <Star Stream> darkened, the 'constellation camp' tasted countless defeats.

And she, who was once a prisoner of the 'constellation camp', had now become an 'Einherjar' representing the camp to fight against the disasters.

Thump. Thump. Thump. Thump.

In the far distance, beyond the dust cloud, the sound of regular vibrations echoed. Cha Yerin knew where that vibration originated.

「Disasters.」

The deformed life forms that this world collectively called so were beyond that cloud. The 'Nameless Things' running while turning the earth over. Following them were the mid-to-large-sized 'Outer World Gods'—the so-called 'Story Eaters'. Cha Yerin stared with calm eyes at the monsters whose very appearance made her shiver.

Since she had been active in the 'Disaster Camp' longer than anyone, she could accurately read their intentions just by observing the movement of the horde.

「The disasters acted as if they would attack the world at any moment, but if looked closely, they were merely existing there.」

The disasters are sad. Because they have no scenarios. Since no one is curious about their stories, they wander around the outer edges of the scenarios all day long, coveting the stories of the gods. Like a child asking to be included in a playground.

「Outer Gods. The existences located 'outside' of this story.」

It was the Administration Bureau that utilized them. Utilizing the Outer World Gods who would do anything just to participate in a story, the Administration Bureau created the role of 'Disaster'.

「The villains who destroy the world of stars.」

But it wasn't as if they always wanted to take on such a role. However, this <Star Stream> did not give them any other role. In that way, years accumulated, and the disasters who had been used to the same role for a long time came to exude threatening stories just by existing.

Incarnations and constellations within the scenarios felt fear and disgust just by looking at them, and burned with hostility.

Yet Cha Yerin knew. Among them, there were certainly warm Outer Gods, and there were also godheads who did not want destruction. While there were those who followed

well like puppies, there were definitely peaceful Outer Gods who came to sleep beside her like cats when night fell.

But Cha Yerin also knew the moments when those cute Outer Gods suddenly changed.

「When this <Star Stream> ordered the disasters to execute 'destruction'.」

Sensing their movement, Cha Yerin jumped down to the inside of the castle wall and shouted,

"The disasters are coming!"

Hearing Cha Yerin's warning, incarnations rang alarm bells everywhere. With a clang, warning lights turned on inside the castle.

「This is the final bastion of 'Ragnarok'.」

Cha Yerin recalled the final flag that would be hanging in the center of the main castle.

「The last fortress of the Einherjar—'Final Sky'.」

If the stars of the constellation camp defending this fortress and even the incarnations were defeated, the <Star Stream> was finished.

[Soon the 'main scenario' will resume!]

[Please defend the final flag.]

[The current number of flags remaining for the 'constellation camp' is '1'!]

[If that flag is taken, your camp will lose the scenario.]

There was no time. Cha Yerin entered straight inside the tent where the officers were gathered.

[The 'chaos level' of this battlefield is extremely high.]

An unpleasantly murky story was floating in the air. It was natural. Because here and now, only the 'surviving existences' from the disasters, regardless of incarnations, constellations, or camps, were gathered.

"Everyone..."

Cha Yerin, who opened the tent and entered, spoke as if to drive away the dark atmosphere,

"It's time to fight."

But no one responded to her words. She turned her head toward a man sitting closest.

"Bang Cheolsoo."

There sat Bang Cheolsoo, the leader of the 'Inho faction'. Hugging his favorite weapon, a bat, with his only remaining arm, he stared at the floor without any response.

「It was last month that Bang Cheolsoo and his colleagues joined the 'constellation camp'.」

Incarnations who had once dreamed of rebellion within the Disaster Camp. However, they were defeated by 'Snow White' in the battle two months ago, and in the process of fleeing from him, they took refuge in the 'constellation camp'.

"Heartless Mother and Daughter."

The Heartless Mother and Daughter were also in the same situation. The mother and daughter sat in a corner of the tent hugging each other tightly, blocking their ears. As if they didn't want to hear any more words. Before them, the ration bread distributed in the afternoon was still untouched.

"Everyone is dead. We're all going to die anyway. We're all going to die."

The daughter of the Heartless Mother and Daughter—Dayoung muttered to herself. Looking down at Dayoung for a moment, Cha Yerin turned her head and said,

"Gong Pildu ahjussi."

Gong Pildu was in a relatively better situation. Because he was an incarnation who joined after the 'Void War' two months ago. His stigma, suited for defensive siege warfare, was more effective in the current battle than any other incarnation. However, it was the same that his face was extremely exhausted. Gong Pildu, who quietly raised his head, asked,

"Is there any news of Hyunwoo?"

Ye Hyunwoo had gone missing after the battle two months ago. Since Gong Pildu was an incarnation who had matched well with Ye Hyunwoo since the Chungmuro days, he

consistently cared about his survival.

"No."

Looking at Cha Yerin shaking her head, Gong Pildu let out a deep sigh. Beside him, the mole cricket Max, whimpering, stuck out its tongue. A mole cricket that grew up with the incarnations and had grown as large as a big dog.

Gong Pildu quietly stroked Max and stood up.

"Let's go. We have to do what we have to do."

Gong Pildu, who stood up stumbling with a body covered in wounds, set out to restore [Armed Fortress]. But Gong Pildu alone was not enough.

"We need more support."

Most of the incarnations here were those who, like her, belonged to the 'Disaster Camp' and then turned to the 'constellation camp'. Usually it would have been an impossible defection, but this time, the situation was special.

「"From now on, all survivors on the Disaster side will be turned into 'Outer Gods'."」

Because the King of the Disasters, 'Snow White', had permitted the defection.

「"Those who do not want to become Outer Gods may leave the Disaster Camp. I promise, there will be no severe punishment for betrayal."」

The incarnations of the Disaster Camp were flustered. Suddenly becoming an Outer God, or choosing defection. As if to help their choice, Snow White said,

「"Ah, and let me tell you one thing. If I win in the last scenario, the <Star Stream> will be destroyed."」

Losing their ego as a human and becoming an Outer God, or becoming the final breakwater to block the destruction. Most of the incarnations who ascended to this place before the final battle chose the latter. It was inevitable. Because the incarnations who survived here by any means were all individuals with that much conviction.

Toward the incarnations leaving the camp as if he expected that, Snow White added with a smile,

「"Try to block me by any means."」

The moment he completed his 'Oldest Dream', everything in this world would go extinct. Therefore, this was a fight to avoid extinction—a war to somehow leave a record.

However, after dozens of bitter struggles, the incarnations came to realize.

「They had started a fight they couldn't win.」

After dozens of bitter struggles, only a few incarnations who could fight remained.

Cha Yerin took a light breath and looked at the opposite side of the tent where the incarnations were gathered. There were the surviving constellations facing the end. She really didn't want to speak to them. Because they were the heinous stars who had enjoyed the pain of the incarnations throughout the scenarios.

...Nevertheless, Cha Yerin bent her pride and spoke,

"Please help."

But no constellation responded. Cha Yerin called the closest constellation.

"One-Eyed Father."

Cha Yerin called the constellation of <Asgard>—'One-Eyed Father' Odin. Odin, regardless of her words, was squatting in a dark corner carving a small sculpture. In his entire body clad in a tattered cape, the halo of a 'Myth-grade constellation' from before could not be seen.

"He Who Begot the King of Kings."

He Who Begot the King of Kings. Jegok, a member of the 'Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors', was also there. He was in the form of a symbolic body, which, to be precise, was the appearance of the dog he raised—Panhu, who had five-colored fur. Jegok came in the form of a dog, licked the back of Cha Yerin's hand, and whimpered. His behavior, as if a regression had occurred, left Cha Yerin speechless.

Biting her lip hard, Cha Yerin looked around again. Most of the constellations who should have been here had left, leaving their places empty. Naturally, she didn't think they had gone to the battlefield. Because they had never stepped to the front of the battlefield even once after the battle two months ago.

Then, there was only one constellation she could ask.

"Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Seas."

She really didn't want to request his help. But right now, even that was desperate. If that constellation would just step forward once and draw his spear, they could sweep away the small-to-mid-sized Outer Gods at once. That alone could save many incarnations. That was exactly as far as she expected.

[I refuse.]

And the expected answer returned. Poseidon, who gulped down the beer placed on the round table, looked down at the floor with eyes devoid of any emotion. There, his broken star relic—the Trident—was rolling around.

「Cha Yerin now knew what kind of expression a star with a broken heart makes.」

When pride and conviction turn to ashes, and the greatness of the story one was proud of is denied, does a star make such an expression?

[Young incarnation, why do you fight so desperately?]

Wiping the beer foam from his mouth, Poseidon asked in a hostile tone.

[We will lose anyway. No matter who comes, this end cannot be blocked.]

Poseidon, who spoke so, had more than half of his incarnation body made of prosthetic parts. In the last battle, Poseidon had lost most of his true body and incarnation body, and his status was also greatly weakened. The battle that put him in that state was also something Cha Yerin knew well from hearing about it.

Two months ago, the sky of the <Star Stream> shone brighter than ever. <Olympus>, <Asgard>, <Vedas>, <Papyrus>, <Huangdi>... the prominent Myth-grade constellations of each nebula gathered to kill a single existence.

「Snow White. Or the existence called the 'Master of the Erased Void'.」

They were the stars at the very top of this sky, and if they set their minds to it, there was no miracle they could not perform.

「The battle known as the 'Void War'.」

The spears and blades of the Myth-grade constellations flew at a single existence. Shaking earth and sky, probability raged, and relentless thunderbolts struck.

「And that day, the stars lost.」

That was all the fact Cha Yerin knew. The Myth-grade constellations lost, and the sky of the <Star Stream> darkened. And the surviving stars all became ruined stars like that Poseidon.

[Pitiable human incarnation. You should have stayed by his side. Even if you become an Outer God, if you win in the final record, you at least...]

"Shut up."

Even though she dared to interrupt the true voice of a Myth-grade constellation, Poseidon did not get angry. Instead, he merely smirked with a self-deprecating expression.

[The myth of the stars has completely set.]

Raising his head, he was looking up at the sky through the torn tent. A sky pitch black even during the day. Counting the few remaining stars in that sky, Poseidon muttered,

[Today, 'Eternal Night' will come to <Star Stream>.]

And a roar resounded from somewhere. It was the sound announcing the final battle of this world.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1043 Episode 64. Eternal Night (2)

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Cha Yerin ran straight toward the battlefield. The battlefield was already a complete mess due to the disasters.

The urgent voice of an incarnation in charge of the first line of outer wall barricades reached her ears.

"The barricades are collapsing!"

It was called a barricade, but it was a first line of defense that could barely block even the 'Nameless Things'. At one point, even that barricade was imbued with the story of a 'Myth-grade Constellation'. But now that the stars had lost their light, it was nothing more than a pile of scrap metal.

"Uaaah!"

Incarnations who had not yet evacuated near the defensive line bent over with screams. Instead of attacking those incarnations, the 'Nameless Things' pushed past the barricades and descended toward the second line of defense.

"Stay down! Just a little more—"

If you do not resist, they will not attack. That was the singular characteristic of the disasters that descended in this 'Ragnarok'. In particular, the lowest-grade disasters, the

'Nameless Things', did not bother touching incarnations who showed no intent to resist. As if killing the incarnations was not their purpose.

However, they were not completely safe just because they didn't resist.

"We have to move now! Run!"

At Cha Yerin's warning, the incarnations who had crouched stood up and began to run. However, there was an Outer God approaching even faster than them.

Kugugugugu.

Giant disasters resembling black spheres were rolling from behind the 'Nameless Things' with a roaring sound.

"Save me! Kuaaa!"

With a sharp scream, an incarnation was crushed under a sphere. If they were an incarnation who had reached this scenario, being crushed slightly under a heavy object wouldn't make their body explode and kill them instantly. But this time was different.

「Story Eaters.」

These godheads of the other world, belonging to the 'mid-sized disasters', were characterized by moving their giant sphere-like bodies to crush everything in their sight. The places they touched lost all vitality and became desolate deserts, which was due to their 'story collection' characteristic.

「Disasters that roll around while constantly collecting stories of the area.」

Because of that, incarnations who approached near them without knowing were struck by tentacles and had all their stories stolen.

"Run! It's a Story Eater!"

The incarnations each used skills like [Nimble Movements] or [Instant Acceleration] to quickly retreat from the first line of defense. But at the next moment, the movement of the Story Eaters changed strangely. Discovering the fleeing incarnations, the Story Eater suddenly stood in place and let out a bizarre cry toward the sky.

[Kkigigigig—!]

Cha Yerin, who knew their pattern beforehand, shouted.

"Cover your ears!"

Sure enough, some incarnations with experience quickly covered their ears or blocked their hearing. The problem was the incarnations who did not hear the warning.

"Ah—"

The bodies of the incarnations who heard the cry froze in an instant. They froze for exactly about three seconds. And those three seconds were enough time for the Story Eater to devour the incarnations.

"Kuaaa!"

A bundle of tentacles rising from the Story Eater's sphere emitted gas and pierced the incarnations like syringes.

"Keo-heok! Save me—!"

But no one could save the dying incarnations. There was no way to save them in the first place. If they ran in blindly, they would all become prey for the Eaters due to the tentacles that popped out one after another.

"Everyone run!"

"Uaaah!"

With that, the first line of defense collapsed completely. Thinking that she could no longer delay, Cha Yerin equipped her claws, and as if waiting for this, Gong Pildu's voice rang out.

"Leave this place to me!"

Gong Pildu, who summoned the Armed Fortress, began supporting with artillery fire.

Dududududu!

Hot bullets traversed the battlefield and pierced the heads of the 'Nameless Things'. It was a scene reminiscent of Chungmuro's 'Emergency Defense Battle', but its scale was incomparable to the 'Emergency Defense Battle'.

Kyaaaa!

The heads of the 'Nameless Things' running in the lead exploded due to Gong Pildu's reinforced magic bullets, which had grown stronger over the scenarios. Confirming hostility, the 'Nameless Things' began running toward the Armed Fortress all at once.

"Protect the Armed Fortress!"

As Gong Pildu's Armed Fortress stood at the lead of the second line of defense, nearby incarnations also gathered around the Armed Fortress.

[The constellation, 'Defense Master', bestows a blessing upon his incarnation!]

The 'Defense Master', who had grown steadily alongside Gong Pildu, also revealed his power. The second line of defense, which was being pushed back amidst the pouring gunfire, was restored once again through the active efforts of the Armed Fortress. Probably, the 'Nameless Things' would be handled to some extent with this.

The problem was the 'Story Eaters' rolling fiercely behind them.

"Kuaaa!"

An incarnation caught by the Story Eater's tentacles reached out toward Cha Yerin. But it was already too late. The moment the tentacles pierced, the incarnation, whose stories were completely drained, turned into a mummy in an instant and crumbled.

「Although the 'Story Eaters' were threatening on their own, because of their potential, they belonged to the targets that had to be handled with priority over other 'mid-sized Outer Gods'.」

If Story Eaters consume a large amount of stories, they evolve into 'Named'—that is, Outer Gods of the 'Old One' class. Because of this, she had to handle the 'Story Eaters' before they entered the evolution stage to secure superiority on the battlefield.

The problem was that to defeat a 'Story Eater', three skilled Historical-grade Constellations, or a Fable-grade Constellation was needed.

「The number of 'Story Eaters' currently visible was ten.」

Cha Yerin caught her breath and raised the stories of her whole body.

[The story, 'Way of the Wind', begins its storytelling!]

[Way of the Wind] which she had obtained at the 'Recycling Center'. Storm-like wind blades began to flow from her entire body.

Gyiaaaa!

The 'Nameless Things' that had been hastily approaching screamed as they were torn to pieces. She accelerated just like that and ran toward the nearest 'Story Eater'. Sensing the threat, the 'Story Eater' stretched out tentacles to check her. Piercing through the first tentacle, a dazzling aura bloomed from Cha Yerin's entire body.

[Fighting Action Mode].

Originally, [Fighting Action Mode] was a skill that could only be properly used when her brother, Cha Seongwoo, was present. However, after painstaking efforts, she became able to draw out the performance of [Fighting Action Mode] to some extent on her own.

Seogeok!

Aiming for an opening, Cha Yerin's claws cut out the Story Eater's outer skin. Almost simultaneously, the formidable energy harbored in the claws explosively swirled, digging into the interior of the Story Eater.

「"Dark Spinning Breaker."」

If her brother had been by her side, he would have said that. Cha Yerin bit her lip tightly and infused more powerful magic into the claws. Unable to withstand the expansion of the energy lodged inside its body, the first 'Story Eater' exploded miserably.

"Yerin-ah! Watch out!"

Gong Pildu's shout echoed from afar. Already, other 'Story Eaters' were approaching.

「Each Story Eater has a different grade.」

The two specimens running toward her now were more powerful than the one she had handled previously.

[P r e y P r e y P r e y P r e y]

Cha Yerin felt a familiar story from the approaching 'Story Eaters'. The 'Story Eaters' before her eyes were beings she once knew.

「Stars that clung to Snow White.」

Although many incarnations left 'Snow White's' subordinate position and chose the 'Constellation Camp', conversely, there were also stars who crawled under 'Snow

White's' command on their own feet. Stars that chose to submit to the 'Oldest Dream' and be recorded at the world's end, even if it meant throwing away their honor as constellations. Now, having lost their sense of self and become disasters, they were running to devour Cha Yerin's stories.

[O o o o o]

Looking at the Eaters approaching right in front of her, Cha Yerin made a quick judgment. The buff of [Fighting Action Mode] alone wasn't enough to handle both.

[The Incarnation, 'Cha Yerin', reveals her status!]

She pulled up all her stories as if squeezing them. The energy harbored in her claws gradually deepened, eventually becoming close to a golden color. At the same time, a formidable status began to flow from her entire body.

「A realm that could be reached only because she was a 'Reader' who survived to the end.」

A natural intelligence that allowed her to learn [Way of the Wind] in 30 minutes. An outstanding comprehension as a reader. Furthermore, having undergone a metamorphosis after eating the 'Holy Oil Fruit' that Cha Seongwoo had obtained for her, she had reached as far as the 4th stage of transcendence in the final scenario.

「Transcendence Stage 4.」

In an instant, a status surpassing the power of a Fable-grade Constellation raged from her entire body. As her madly beating heart pumped stories, an unbelievable superhuman strength welled up from her whole body. With a whooshing sound, her claws emitted light.

One. The first 'Story Eater' was hacked to pieces by her claws.

Two. A large hole was pierced in the center of the second 'Story Eater' by her claws that thrust as she spun and turned.

'It's not over yet.'

Two 'Story Eaters', who had approached stealthily underground by hiding in the shadows of the other Eaters, shot up from beneath her feet.

[Kkigigigig—]

She blocked her hearing using the power of her stories and leapt into the air. In an instant, the rushing tentacles narrowly pierced through the empty air. The moment the 'Story Eaters', startled by her sudden wit, hesitated, Cha Yerin activated [Fighting Action Mode].

「"Shadow Breaker."」

The ultimate technique of [Fighting Action Mode]. A golden energy storm erupted from the shadows of the 'Story Eaters'. Torn apart by the energy that poured down in their moment of carelessness, the two 'Story Eaters' collapsed with rough screams.

[Fighting Action Mode is deactivated.]

[Combat Summary: Combo Score 88 points! Your lonely struggle fighting alone is remarkable.]

Falling straight to the ground, Cha Yerin stumbled.

「This was the limit.」

Due to the long battle, her incarnation body had already reached its limit, and the flow of her stories was not in a normal state.

[Warning! Your incarnation body has reached its limit!]

[Your stories are beginning to flow backward!]

Defeating five mid-sized disasters single-handedly.

[You have achieved an amazing feat!]

[<Star Stream> is filled with admiration at your active performance!]

A feat that normally would have brought a shower of admiration and sponsorship from the stars. But there was not a single starlight shining down on her. This was because all the stars that used to watch over her had already fallen long ago.

In the distance, she saw the 'Story Eaters' approaching her. Exactly five specimens. Just as many as she had defeated still remained. Moreover, this was only the beginning. Amidst the surging army of disasters, there would easily be hundreds more of those 'Story Eaters'.

‘Brother.’

Even if she was lucky enough to handle all those Eaters, at the rear of the army were large Outer Gods of the 'Interstellar Predator' class—the 'Old Ones'—who were more powerful than them. Even if, by some miracle, she defeated all those Outer Gods, behind them stood the monstrous 'Snow White', who could extinguish all starlight in the sky just by blinking.

‘What was the sight you saw at the end, brother?’

Cha Yerin infused the last of her magic into her claws and thought about her brother, Cha Seongwoo.

「"Yerin-ah. That is not the correct interpretation."」

The person who loved this world more than anyone. If he had been by her side, what advice would he have given her? If it were her brother, who had read the same story a hundred times, would he have been able to find a way to resolve this situation?

Cheucheucheut.

The moment her magic cut out, her knees buckled. Not missing the opening, the lead 'Story Eater' stretched out its tentacles. Held powerlessly, her claws made a snapping sound. The broken blade rolled on the ground, and Cha Yerin looked up at the dark sky. A faint chuckle escaped her. That pitch-black scenery, where nothing could be seen, was a sight more familiar to her than anyone else. Perhaps it was just returning to how everything was before it all began. Thinking that made her feel a little more at peace.

Certain of her death, the last thing she recalled was the existence she had resented all this time.

I want to see a star.

Just once, I want to see a dazzling star that brightens the darkness of that sky.

Thinking that wish was ridiculous, the moment she closed her eyes, she felt as if a part of the distant night sky was growing bright.

"Ah."

At first, she thought it was her imagination. But the moment she saw the approaching Eaters falter and stop, Cha Yerin realized something.

「At least one star that watched over her remained on this battlefield.」

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< Episode 64. Eternal Night (2) > End

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1044 Episode 64. Eternal Night (3)

Cha Yerin suddenly snapped back to her senses. Her blurry surroundings returned, and a gentle story wrapped around her shoulders.

「There was a star that descended before her eyes.」

A star that loftily illuminated the dark sky. That star was guarding the space before her. A distinct elegance was felt in the light flowing from his entire body. The spirit to guard the sky alone even if all stars were to be extinguished. The moment she confirmed that momentum, Cha Yerin suddenly realized who the star in front of her was.

[The constellation, 'Supreme God of Light', is looking at you.]

He was one of the few stars remaining in the 'Constellation Camp'. A constellation who had kept the last bastion by burning all of his stories.

"Surya Ahjussi!"

At that, the brightly shining sun nodded toward her.

[Step back, incarnation of the Korean Peninsula.]

An astonishing status flowed from Surya's entire body as he burst out with True Voice.

[The constellation, 'Supreme God of Light', reveals his status!]

Although he could not share stories with <Kim Dokja Company> in this 41st round, he was still one of the great 'Lokapalas' of <Vedas>, and now, the sole star of the giant nebula <Vedas>.

[I am your opponent, abominations of the other world.]

Having participated in 'Ragnarok' since the early days, he was in a state of undergoing treatment after sustaining major injuries in the accumulated battles. More than half of his incarnation body was wrapped in bandages. However, as if he did not care about the injuries at all, he stepped forward while melting the bandages with the intense heat radiating from his entire body.

「He was the last remaining sun of <Vedas>. The final Lokapala.」

Even in a situation where Indra, one of the Lokapalas, and the Myth-grade constellations had vanished, the last star of <Vedas> did not yield before the disasters.

At his appearance, all the godheads of the other world in the area let out roars.

[O o o o o o o]

The 'Nameless Things' instinctively felt aversion and backed away, but the higher-grade specimens were different. In particular, the moment the Story Eaters sensed Surya's stories, they began rolling toward this side like crazy.

"It's dangerous!"

The moment Cha Yerin warned him, Surya's True Voice blanketed the battlefield.

[Stop.]

The eye engraved on his forehead was shining brightly. Surya's stigma, [Third Eye], had activated.

「Surya's stigma that dominates time and space, [Third Eye].」

[Third Eye] was a stigma that dominated the cognitive system of all beings that met its gaze. Anyone who met that eye had no choice but to become a 'slave of time and space' dominated by Surya.

「However, there was no change in the movement of the 'Story Eaters'.」

It was perhaps natural. The 'Story Eaters' before their eyes were those who were once constellations but had betrayed their camp to become Outer Gods. Because they had forgotten the greatness of Surya's stories, they could not understand them properly, and since even their cognitive system of time and space was different, the power of [Third Eye] did not work on them.

[Foolish things.]

Even so, Surya was not flustered.

[The story, 'King of the Twelve Suns', has begun its storytelling!]

If they do not know, he just has to make them know. An even more powerful status of the story flowed from his entire body. Sensing the story, the 'Story Eaters' accelerated even further and rushed in. Their greed was reacting to Surya's story. The scent and rays of light flowing from the story. The lingering imagery of the story that could be felt without even eating began to dominate their senses. And at a certain moment.

[Kkigigigig...?]

Their movements froze. Their rolling speed gradually slowed down, and they soon stopped ten paces away from Surya.

[Kkiiiiiii—!]

At last, the capability of [Third Eye] had manifested. Looking at the slightly trembling spheres, Surya spoke.

[Do you now realize who the being in front of you is?]

Startled, the 'Story Eaters' belatedly changed directions and began fleeing backward. But it was already too late. Before long, twelve suns were rising in neat alignment behind Surya's back.

[Burn.]

Along with Surya's command, high-pressure solar rays swept the battlefield. It was truly an overwhelming destructive power. The heat of the brightly shining sun swept away all the 'Story Eaters' and the 'Nameless Things' in the area.

This was Surya's real strength. A great authority that only a constellation who had relentlessly trained and refined their story could harbor. Although Surya had not risen to the 'Myth-grade', he possessed a higher 'Narrative-grade' status that was more complete than anyone else.

Surya caught his breath for a moment, then turned back and asked.

[Are you alright?]

Cha Yerin approached with an emotional expression. Surya's incarnation body was not in a normal state. From his body, which had a slight frown on its brow, stories were leaking out without cease.

"Surya Ahjussi, the damage to your incarnation body is too severe."

However, the battlefield did not grant them any leisure.

"Yerin-ah! It's not over yet!"

Along with Gong Pildu's voice echoing from afar, the sound of something surging from the ground was heard. Just as screams seemed to echo from the center of the second line of defense, a 'Story Eater' soon revealed its shape.

「There were more Story Eaters.」

Two 'Story Eaters' that had stealthily moved underground had bypassed Cha Yerin and Surya to approach near the Armed Fortress.

"Kuaaa!"

In an instant, the captured incarnations began to have their stories absorbed by the Story Eater. Cha Yerin activated [Way of the Wind] and ran over, but the damage was already severe.

"You bastards!"

Gong Pildu showered bullets toward the Story Eaters that were ruthlessly driving in their tentacles.

"Die! Just die!"

However, the tough shell of the Story Eater was completely unfazed by Gong Pildu's magic bullets.

Soon, just as the Story Eater's tentacles were about to target Gong Pildu atop the fortress, Surya, who arrived simultaneously with Cha Yerin, moved.

Kwadudeuk!

Surya swung his hand blade wrapped in a majestic story and crushed one Story Eater just like that. A constellation's hand-to-hand combat, which was rarely shown. The situation was just that urgent.

"There's one more left!"

Surya nodded as if he knew. In the direction of his gaze, there was a 'Story Eater' of an unusual size. The one that had ended up devouring all the incarnations near the second line of defense. Faint cracks were appearing all over its body.

[It is dangerous.]

Along with Surya's words, Cha Yerin also infused energy into her claws. The cracks on the Story Eater's body were gradually increasing. An ominous energy felt inside the sphere. There was no mistake. That specimen was evolving now. If that Story Eater grew to the class of an 'Old One', even Surya would find it difficult to deal with.

[We destroy it now.]

Surya's sun emitted rays, and the energy storming from Cha Yerin's claws hacked the Story Eater's body to pieces. No matter how much of a Named Outer God it was, it couldn't possibly be safe after taking such a bombardment in its pre-evolution stage.

However, amidst the thick dust created by the bombardment, a strange cry was heard.

[Kkigigigigigigi]

An ominous aura of chaos spewed out in streaks through the dust. Surya immediately realized what had happened.

[It sacrificed itself to call a 'higher-grade disaster'.]

Sensing its end, the Story Eater had instinctively offered the stories it absorbed to call for help from a 'higher-grade disaster'.

[Step behind me!]

The moment Surya opened up his status with those words, a massive wave of chaos encroached the area. A powerful status, enough to push back even Gong Pildu's Armed Fortress, was overflowing in the vicinity.

Soon, the pitch-black sphere split open, and an anomalous existence stood up inside. The moment she confirmed that existence, Cha Yerin muttered while shivering.

"Interstellar Predator."

An 'Old One'. A monster positioned at the very topmost class among them descended upon the battlefield. A body height exceeding tens of meters. A 'humanoid Outer God' that looked like a pitch-black shadow stared down with empty pupils.

[A new disaster has descended upon the battlefield!]

[The God of the Other World, 'One Who Brings Forth the Ancient Night', has descended upon the battlefield!]

Although it wasn't large for a large-sized Outer God, its status was nevertheless truly beyond imagination.

「'Interstellar Predators' were beings under the direct command of Snow White.」

Surya couldn't block that either. It was a situation where only Myth-grade constellations coming would make it worth trying to pick a fight, yet Surya did not back down.

[Incarnation. Take the survivors and hide inside the inner castle.]

"Ahjussi! You can't!"

Despite Cha Yerin's cry, Surya shook his head.

[If it's just that fellow alone, I might be able to manage somehow.]

Every star instinctively realizes the moment when it will shine for the last time. Surya was the same.

「Now was the moment for his starlight to flare up for the last time.」

Although he had never fought the 'Master of the Erased Whitespace', that Outer God, whom even Myth-grade constellations found hard to oppose, was sufficient as his final opponent.

The head of the massive disaster tilted very slowly.

[S m a l l s t a r]

[S t i l l]

[R e m a i n i n g]

The moment they heard the segmented True Voice of the Interstellar Predator echoing, the incarnations in the area sat down, experiencing breathing difficulties.

[Indeed, I am still here.]

Surya spoke in True Voice as if to wake those incarnations. Snapping out of it belatedly, the incarnations hurriedly fled toward the castle.

However, Cha Yerin did not flee. Even if she fled, it would only be temporary. If Surya could not defeat that 'Interstellar Predator' here, there was no way for humanity to survive.

[I am the Supreme God of Light.]

Rising into the air, stories flowed from Surya's entire body.

[It is the name of the star that will burn you.]

His twelve suns emitted rays simultaneously, and [Third Eye] manifested its authority. A chain of light that collapsed cognitive systems and burned down all living things. Staring head-on at that radiance, which felt like it would blind one just by looking, the Interstellar Predator let out a bizarre sound that was either a sigh or a sneer.

[Ha]

In an instant, the world felt like it was distorting with a throb. The moment Cha Yerin, struck by an ominous premonition, reached out her hand toward Surya—

[Hahahahahahahahahahahahahahahaha—!]

Along with a chilling laugh, everything in the area was swept away. The barricades of the defensive line, the incarnations fleeing in haste, and even Gong Pildu's Armed Fortress broke down.

Cha Yerin saw Surya's suns, which were guarding the space in front of her, slowly cracking. She heard sounds as if stars were exploding one after another before her eyes. An explosion sound that made her ears ring. After recovering her senses in the shock and barely raising her head, Cha Yerin realized that the sky had grown slightly darker.

"Surya Ahjussi!"

Clearing through the rising dust, Cha Yerin ran toward Surya. Broken remnants of Surya's suns were rolling on the ground. And—

「In the place where the light was extinguished, the last star of this battlefield was hanging dangling.」

With one arm and leg torn off, Surya's charred incarnation body was hanging limply. Holding that Surya with its giant fingers, the Interstellar Predator smirked and spoke.

[T w i n k l e t w i n k l e l i t t l e s t a r]

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< Episode 64. Eternal Night (3) > End

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1045 Episode 64. Eternal Night (4)

Before that overwhelming violence, Cha Yerin could not even move. Only a nauseating despair dominated the battlefield. Unable to either flee or fight back, she simply watched Surya's end.

[I s t h e r e n o t h i n g m o r e e n t e r t a i n i n g ?]

At that moment, along with a faint ray of light, Surya's incarnation body escaped the Outer God's grasp. Cha Yerin let out a sigh of relief.

"Ah—"

Fortunately, Surya was still alive. However, judging from his felt status, he seemed to find it burdensome just to maintain his incarnation body. Yet, Surya's eyes were still blazing.

[There is still one left.]

As if this fight was not over yet.

[A 'story' that you will like.]

The moment the Interstellar Predator's head tilted, Cha Yerin heard a sound echoing from incredibly far away.

The sound of a giant wheel moving. The sound of an engine expanding and contracting its iron-like lungs. The sound of iron wheels scraping the darkness, chewing up and swallowing the rails entirely. Cha Yerin knew what that sound was.

「It was the sound of a train running.」

And the only star in this world capable of moving that train right now was here. Along with a horn, the front of the train began to appear beyond the distant sky. It was Surya's star relic.

「Surya's 'Sun Train'.」

His super-large train, capable of interstellar travel, was running while shaking the atmosphere. Cha Yerin clenched both fists. There was a possibility. With the story harbored in that train, and that massive collision energy, they might be able to defeat this damn Outer God.

[T w i n k l e t w i n k l e]

And at the next moment, the Outer God raised a hand.

[E n t e r t a i n i n g]

It was impossible to know what had occurred. All Cha Yerin saw was simply the Outer God's palm. The chills rising on her spine, and only the records of a recorder proved the causality of that event.

「A massive status of chaos was fired from the Outer God's palm, sweeping straight through the sky.」

The train's horn was no longer heard. Cha Yerin sat down like someone who had lost even their last hope. Beyond the distant sky, she saw the shattered fragments of Surya's train falling like meteors. The Outer God laughed.

[E n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g e n t e r t a i n i n g]

Surya let out a bizarre scream.

[Kuaaaaaaa!]

Even though the train was destroyed, Surya did not give up. The train was still responding to his story. He raised his story and summoned the train fragments that responded to him. The broken train fragments flew at a fierce speed like meteors and pierced the Outer God's main body.

Peogeogeogeok!

Hit by the train fragments imbued with a powerful story, the Outer God stumbled.

Peogeok! Peogeogeogeok!

Each and every one was a fragment containing massive story energy. A strike containing everything of Surya's, which no monster could possibly withstand. Nevertheless, the Outer God did not fall.

Soon, when all the flying fragments had disappeared, the Interstellar Predator spoke.

[S o m e t h i n g m o r e e n t e r t a i n i n g]

It pulled out the train fragments lodged in its body and munched on them. As if it wouldn't even hurt no matter how many times it was hit by this kind of attack.

Surya let out a hollow laugh. Now, the story flowing from his entire body was growing weaker and weaker. If it still didn't work after doing all this, there was nothing more he could do.

「Surya accepted the conclusion of this world.」

If he died here—and if this fortress collapsed because of that—the era of stars and humans was now over.

「Vedas.」

Ragnarok would end in the victory of 'disaster', and destruction would eventually blanket the entirety of <Star Stream>.

「Star Stream.」

Even so, there was nothing more he could do now.

「This was my final story.」

Despite that solemn testament, the sky was still dark. No one cheered for his story, nor did anyone grieve for his ■■. Looking at the terrifyingly quiet sky of <Star Stream>, Surya smiled bitterly. Who would believe it now? That there was once an era when that sky was dazzlingly bright.

Before long, having lost interest, the Outer God's giant finger moved slowly toward Surya.

[U n e n t e r t a i n i n g]

Looking at the dark shadow of the Outer God blanketing him, Surya, strangely enough, recalled a story told to him by an unfamiliar incarnation.

「"Do you know? The you that I knew drove a truly amazing train. Shall I show you a little?"」

The squinty-eyed incarnation, who carried around many unique stories, had told him his story.

「Surya's entire body, sitting in the engine room of the train, was dazzling like the incandescent sun.」

What on earth was that story back then?

「Without showing any signs, he ran the [Sun Train] using his own body as fuel. As if that was his mission having lived as the 'Supreme God of Light' until now.」

Surya, who drove the Sun Train by offering all of his stories. The 'Final Engineer' who was running for something, for some mission.

Between the stories flowing by like a dream, the Outer God's giant finger moved. The massive finger of the disaster gathering its thumb and middle finger as if catching a bug. Soon, a gale blew, and the giant middle finger flew toward him.

Tung.

At first, he thought it was the sound of his body breaking like a bug. However, even as time passed, Surya could not feel any pain. Blinking his eyes with a lightly flickering spark, he saw a dazzling story wrapping around his entire body.

[The Giant Story, 'Vedas', protects your story.]

Surya was shocked. There was no way. Because, except for him, there were no proper stars left in <Vedas>. The powerful Myth-grade constellations had all disappeared, and that arrogant Indra and the great Lokapalas had all died. Then who on earth had moved this story?

[I am glad I am not too late, friend.]

Turning his head, a constellation surrounded by flames just as hot was standing while supporting him.

[Agni!]

He was a member of the great <Lokapala>, the 'Flame of Purification' Agni. The one who had been temporarily sent out of the 'main battlefield' due to his injuries had rejoined the battlefield.

[Why did you come here! I'm sure I told you not to come!]

Agni's incarnation body was still in a vulnerable state. A state that felt like it would easily collapse even under a slight impact.

[Have you not seen who the opponent is? With you alone—]

It was not a fight where the outcome would change just because a single Agni came. Honestly, let alone Agni, even if Mithra of his prime, the 'Master of December 25th'—a Myth-grade constellation of <Vedas>—returned, it was uncertain whether that monster could be defeated.

However, Agni shook his head.

[Do not worry. I am not alone.]

Surya could not understand Agni's words. Perhaps his companion had been away from the battlefield for too long and his head had gone a bit strange. No matter who came, there was no way to block that monster. Even if a Myth-grade constellation came—

[Someone more greater than a Myth-grade constellation will come.]

A constellation more greater than a Myth-grade constellation. Surya could not fathom who on earth that referred to. Only his senses were telling him.

「Something is approaching from very far away.」

Since when was it? The train's horn, which had definitely disappeared, was heard once again. Surya slowly raised his head. Then, he saw something flying toward this side from beyond that sky.

「It was his train.」

Surya looked up at that scenery as if in a dream. The Outer God also let out a strange cry, perhaps having felt something.

[O o o o o o o ?]

It was an incomprehensible, impossible miracle.

[E n t e r t a i n i n g]

Clearly, his train was destroyed. Yet, his destroyed train was running while neatly restored. Moreover, the front of the train had changed to a much more modern appearance than before.

[The constellation, 'Mass Production Maker', smiles broadly.]

The southern direction of the sky brightened faintly. Startled, Surya raised his head and muttered.

[That fellow is—]

The Mass Production Maker. He knew his reputation well from hearing it. If it were that constellation, it was not strange that he had restored the train with his power in this instant. However, why did he, famous for rarely stepping forward, suddenly appear on this battlefield?

Subsequently, the north of the sky flashed, and a thunder-like True Voice was heard.

[What is this? I thought you were someone with rare grit. Don't tell me you're already trying to give up!]

Surya knew who the owner of the voice was. He was definitely the naked ape of the heavenly realm, the 'Monkey King'. Subsequently, the west of the sky also brightened.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', snorts and stares at you.]

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon. With even the proud ancient evil dragon appearing, Surya felt as if he had no idea what was what. That evil dragon was definitely supposed to be staying in the 'hole' in despair over the frustration of the 'Great War of Saints and Demons'...

Finally, the eastern direction of the sky brightened.

[The constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', cheers for you.]

The strongest archangel that <Eden> was proud of. Receiving her gentle starlight, Surya opened his mouth with a blank face.

[Agni, don't tell me they...]

It was true that every single one of them was an amazing constellation. However, they were by no means stars that had reached the 'Myth-grade'. Though they might serve as a straw to grasp in this situation, even if they came, they could not repel the 'Interstellar Predator'.

[No. He will arrive soon.]

Simultaneously with Agni's response, the Outer God raised one hand. His right hand targeted the train running from the distant sky.

[Hahahahahahahahahahahahahahahaha—!]

Along with a horrific laugh, a storm-like status of chaos poured toward the train once again. Surya bit his lip tightly. Earlier, his train was shattered into pieces by that attack. No matter how outstanding a constellation the 'Mass Production Maker' was, there was no way to withstand that attack...

[Hahahaha... Ha?]

What was going on? Despite the Outer God's attack, the train was running perfectly fine. Without a single delay, like a train running right on schedule. At the train's nonchalant horn, the Outer God raised both hands this time.

[Hahahahaha! Hahahahahah! Hahahahahahahahahah!]

A vast status of chaos surged from both of the Outer God's hands. A story of chaos that was more than enough to turn the sky into a pitch-black sea. Despite that overwhelming story majesty that completely changed the weather of the area, the train was running even more vigorously, opposing the story.

At that unbelievable sight, Surya muttered while stumbling.

[What on earth is that...]

Looking closely, there was a story wrapped around the train. A story he was seeing for the first time—no, perhaps it was a story he had seen once.

[Giant Story, 'Torch That Swallowed the Myth', roars!]

At that moment, Surya thought of the scenery of the story he had peeked at long ago. The train led by the last engineer, running toward the end of the world.

[Hahahahahahahahahahahahahahahahahahah!]

The Outer God urgently howled and drew out all of its strength. However, the train had already reached right in front of it. Belatedly realizing something, the Outer God screamed and backed away.

[U n e n t e r t a i n i n g]

As if belatedly realizing who the existence riding that train was.

[U n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g u n e n t e r t a i n i n g]

With a roaring sound, the train collided with the Outer God's massive body. A vast aftershock arose, and story fragments bounced in all directions. Surya and Agni deployed defensive walls with all their might to block the aftershock. When the aftershock subsided to some extent, Surya urgently approached the collision point. In the place where the aftershock had cleared lay the fallen massive body of the Outer God. And his train—having precisely penetrated the center of the Outer God and torn it to pieces, had arrived on the ground.

"No, how can you drive that way!"

[Urgh, my apologies. It is my first time driving a train as well—]

A voice heard from somewhere. The first to react was Cha Yerin. Standing up amidst the dust, Cha Yerin stumbled and ran toward the train.

At that moment, Cha Yerin thought of her brother. She had not properly seen her brother's end. Instead, she had heard the story. That her brother had found out about the 'conclusion' of this entire world at the last moment. And that 'Snow White' seemed to be surprised after hearing the conclusion he had found out.

Cha Yerin did not know what conclusion her brother had found out. However, at least now, she felt she knew what the first scene of the conclusion her brother had seen at the end was.

「Someone was standing on top of the train.」

Her brother, who had read the same story almost a hundred times or more. The first scenery imagined by him, who had lived in this world to see the end of his favorite story.

「He was the only Kim Dokja who could write this 'next story'.」

The protagonist of the story her brother had waited for was standing there, his white coat fluttering.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Rewrites Eternity', begins his recording.]

As many as eight years had passed. It was a face she had not seen for a long time. Nevertheless, the moment she saw his face, Cha Yerin had no choice but to recognize who he was.

"I am sorry for being late, Yerin-ssi."

Because Cha Yerin could recognize his face even when her eyes were blind. The face she had imagined countless times in the pitch-black darkness. The protagonist, who finally revealed his face on top of the train where starlight that cleared the darkness was pouring down, spoke.

"It won't be late anymore."

「 And finally, all the Kim Dokjas gathered in 'Ragnarok'.」

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< Episode 64. Eternal Night (4) > End

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1046 Episode 64. Eternal Night (5)

The reunion was short. Whether she lost tension after seeing me, Cha Yerin collapsed straight away as if fainting. Lightly supporting her, I requested treatment from the Mass Production Maker.

[Do not worry.]

A group of stewards appeared from the Mass Production Maker's warship and began to take care of her.

"The incarnation body is heavily damaged."

"Bring more story packs!"

Cha Yerin had defended that castle at the very front lines until her incarnation body became like this. I couldn't understand. What on earth were the other existences of the 'Constellation Camp' doing elsewhere until she was pushed this far? Yoo Joonghyuk, and the other stars—

[You are...]

Turning my head, Surya, supported by Agni, was looking at me.

"It has been a while, Supreme God of Light."

I had seen Surya twice until now. Once was while being chased by constellations in the 'Recycling Center', and another time was in the 'New Murim District'. Of course, I had also met the 1,864th round Surya in the Fear Realm. Surya who traveled the worlds after his ending. However, since he wasn't the Surya in front of my eyes, I did not mention it.

[You have really changed a lot.]

Perhaps having felt my story, Surya's tone carried a hint of admiration.

"Thank you for protecting Yerin-ssi."

I expressed my sincere gratitude to him. The only star that came out to the battlefield and fought against the disasters. Had he not been here, this fortress would have been destroyed before I arrived.

[It was not done to receive thanks. I merely did my best since it was the given scenario.]

"Still, thank you. Had it not been for you, the damage would have been greater."

[That incarnation often spoke about you.]

Surya muttered, looking back with blurry eyes at Cha Yerin, who was receiving treatment.

[That perhaps you might come to this battlefield. That you might be the sole existence to oppose that 'Master of the Erased Blank Space'... I had thought it was merely the sleep-talking of an incarnation drenched in despair.]

That blunt Cha Yerin said such things? Perhaps Cha Yerin had built quite a friendship with the Surya in front of her during that time.

[I am grateful for your help.]

It had been a while since I received such an honest greeting from a star, so I smiled broadly and replied.

"No. I am the one who is grateful."

[If it is alright with you...]

Surya looked at me with a somewhat hesitant expression, then added briefly.

[Could we share a talk briefly, even if it is later?]

"Certainly. Anytime."

Hearing the expression 'share a talk' at a time when destruction was right before our noses felt strange once again, but I also thought that it was quite like the stars and humans. Even if destruction comes tomorrow, we talk. Even destruction becomes the material of a story.

[You have succeeded in the 342nd defensive battle!]

As all the main Outer Gods were destroyed, the 'Nameless Things' that were surging from far away were also seen scattering and fleeing.

[You have intruded during the progress of a 'Sub Scenario'.]

[You have played a core role in the corresponding scenario!]

[You obtain 1,000,000 coins as a defense reward!]

A scenario where 1 million coins came in as a simple reward. Indeed, since it was a scenario at the very final stages, the scale was different. Of course, the 'real reward' here wouldn't be coins.

"Found it!"

Some of the surviving incarnations were already digging through the heaps of dead Outer Gods' corpses to pick up stories that might be useful to them. Gathering stories when their companions had been dying just moments ago—anyone looking might call it a psychopathic judgment, but rather, it was possible because they were incarnations who had survived this far. If they didn't become stronger by picking up even one more story, they couldn't survive the next battlefield. The incarnations here knew that fact better than anyone.

[I will go inspect the corpses for a moment as well.]

The Mass Production Maker beside me also moved stealthily with an itching expression. It was clear what 'corpses' he was going to inspect. I looked at the corpse of the giant Outer God lying dead ten paces away.

「Interstellar Predator.」

It was a massive Outer God that I wouldn't have dared to fight previously. If it was of that grade, it would at least be comparable to the 'Devourer of Dreams'. A corpse of such a high-grade Outer God would definitely have many uses.

[You have achieved an unbelievable feat!]

[A multitude of Outer Gods cannot hide their shock at your status!]

[You have obtained a new story!]

Perhaps because I had slain 'Calamity-grade Disaster', I felt a new story stirring. However, before I could even verify the newly obtained story, something wriggled inside me.

[Your new story is absorbed into your 'Super Giant Story'.]

[Your 'Super Giant Story' is facing the opportunity for its final blooming.]

As expected. Letting out a light sigh, I quietly stared at the stories within me. The Super Giant Story. The moment to use this fellow in earnest was finally approaching.

[You have successfully completed the the 'Returnee Scenario'!]

[You have satisfied all completion conditions of the 'Hidden Scenario'.]

[Beyond subjugating the Kings of the 'Hall', you have united all Kings of the 'Hall'!]

A Hidden Scenario. Apparently, obtaining the cooperation of all the Kings was the hidden completion condition of the previous scenario.

[You are awarded the special reward for the corresponding scenario.]

[There is no predetermined item in this special reward.]

[You can request the item you want as a reward through the dokkaebi in charge from the 'Bureau'.]

[Upon requesting the item reward, whether to grant the reward will be judged according to the Bureau's discretion within the probability allowed by the 'Bureau'.]

It was an interesting story. Requesting a desired reward from the 'Bureau'? There had never been this kind of reward until now.

[The final approver of the corresponding reward is the 'Dokkaebi King'.]

So it meant I could receive any 'item' as long as the 'Dokkaebi King' did not oppose the reward I requested.

[Some Great Dokkaebis oppose the 'special reward' given to you!]

Perhaps considering it as excessively generous, there seemed to be differing opinions within the Bureau. From my perspective, it wasn't a bad thing, but strictly speaking, receiving such a reward at this point was not a situation that could be viewed entirely positively.

「The Bureau has judged that the 'probability scale' of this scenario is completely tilted.」

In other words, they judged there was almost no possibility of our camp winning, even if they gave me such a reward. At this point, I was curious on one hand. I already knew the situation was bad. But just how bad was it that they were encouraging the scenario by giving me even this kind of reward?

[The 'Main Scenario' is updated!]

[You possess an incarnation body suitable for the corresponding scenario.]

An "Suitable incarnation body'. It was the first time I received such a message. Somehow, the scenario system always felt displeased with me. Did it mean I had grown that much?

[You can choose either the 'Constellation Camp' or the 'Disaster Camp' to perform the corresponding scenario.]

[Currently, you have entered the 'Main Battlefield' through the 'Hall'.]

[The 'Constellation Camp' is forcibly assigned to you.]

Along with the messages popping up one after another, the full-fledged 'Main Scenario' window appeared.

**<Main Scenario # 98 - Ragnarok>**

Seeing the number '98' written made me realistically feel that I had finally come this far.

Category: Main

Difficulty: ???

Clear Conditions: You have become an 'Einherjar' of the 'Constellation Camp'. Defeat the disasters of the 'Disaster Camp' along with the stars that follow you.

Time Limit: -

Reward: -

Failure: Destruction of the world and extermination of all living things.

The result being 'destruction of the world and extermination of all living things'. Just hearing it was a sentence that made my hair stand on end.

I thought that the scenario description was somewhat vague, but looking closely, the rules of the 'Main Battlefield' were listed additionally below.

1. The corresponding scenario ends when all 'flags' of the opposing camp are occupied.

2. A total of 12 fortresses exist in each camp, and one flag is preserved in each fortress.

3. Killing the commander of the fortress is also recognized as seizing the fortress's flag.

4. The commander of the fortress is automatically appointed as the 'existence with the highest status' in that fortress.

5. The commander of the fortress must appear in the 'battlefield' within three days when the siege battle begins.

...

Well, to summarize, it felt like this. Attack the enemy's fortress, and occupy the flags. If that doesn't work, kill the commander of the fortress. It really felt like a scenario I had seen somewhere.

I continued checking the contents.

Flags held by the Disaster Camp: 23

Flags held by the Constellation Camp: 1

A situation that naturally brought a sigh. I knew we were being pushed back, but to think it was to this extent.

Did she check the scenario contents like me? I saw Jung Heewon, who was standing far away, approaching this way.

"Dokja-ssi. This really feels like that scenario."

"Yes. It's similar to the fourth scenario."

Looking at the contents alone, it felt like an expanded version of the 'King's Road' after all. Although it was interesting that 'Ragnarok', the scenario of great destruction, resembled the early scenario, predictably, there was no way this was all there was to the final scenario.

[A linked 'Hidden Scenario' exists for this scenario.]

This was merely the scenario unfolding on the surface. The real 'main' probably hadn't even begun yet. Perhaps when the conditions of the Hidden Scenario were unlocked, Ragnarok's 'final scenario' would also be updated.

[Heh, is this really the 'Main Battlefield'.]

In the distance, I saw the constellations who were aboard the warships landing outside one by one.

[How on earth could this...]

[I didn't know the situation would be this devastating.]

And on the other hand, there were incarnations glancing at the newly appeared constellations. They were all incarnations who had survived this battle.

"Did reinforcements really come?"

"Ah..."

Although the situation wouldn't change greatly just because a few more constellations were reinforced, their expressions were nevertheless looking much brighter. That was the important thing. That hope to continue the story had arisen.

"Author-nim."

Suddenly turning back, Cha Yerin, who had regained consciousness, was standing there.

"Yerin-ssi. Your body..."

"It's fine."

Cha Yerin stood quietly looking at me with a somewhat flushed complexion. Come to think of it, her atmosphere and way of speaking seemed to have changed slightly. The Cha Yerin I knew rarely got excited, angry, or sad and was characterized by speaking in a flat tone as if reading a book. Did those eight years perhaps change even her story?

After looking at me for a long time, Cha Yerin barely managed to utter a word.

"Thank you."

Even upon hearing those words of thanks, I felt miserable instead. Because I couldn't fathom the depth of the countless emotions she must have swallowed to utter that single word. Too many things must have happened to her while I was gone. She lost her

companions, and even her brother. Simply as the price of entering the story she loved, she paid too great a price.

"I am sorry."

"What are you so sorry about?"

"I was too—"

"You're not late."

Cha Yerin spoke, shaking her head.

"You are here now. So you're not late."

I forced a smile. If she said so, then so it was. Therefore, for now, believing her words and thinking about the future was the priority.

Cha Yerin examined me and the other constellations standing behind me with calm eyes. Before long, the four 'Kings' were gathered near me.

"Those people are—"

"They will help us."

Cha Yerin stared at each of the 'Kings' for a moment. Like a long-time reader, she seemed to recognize who they were just by looking. A brief longing rose in her pupils and scattered, and quickly regaining her usual expression, Cha Yerin spoke.

"I will guide you to the castle."

---

Cha Yerin, the other four Kings, and I entered the inner castle and examined the interior. Incarnations and Historical-grade constellations repairing the broken fortress were seen here and there. Most were not combat personnel but seemed to be talents specialized in castle defense.

Gong Pildu, who was repairing the Armed Fortress from afar, waved towards us. Looking closely, the appearances of several incarnations tending to the 'Armed Fortress' were familiar.

"Zarathustra."

Cha Yerin nodded and replied.

"That's right. They are the artisans who followed the prophet."

Whether they also recognized me, a few of them bowed lightly. I also greeted them briefly. By the way, even counting at a glance, the incarnations remaining inside this fortress seemed to be less than a thousand.

"Is this all?"

"For now."

"There must be other forces as well. Surely we aren't just repeating defensive battles here."

"There is a unit that moves independently."

A unit that moves independently.

"Is it Yoo Joonghyuk?"

Cha Yerin nodded slightly. Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round. As expected, he had already arrived here and was fighting the disasters.

"The prophet and Japan's representative incarnation are also moving together as well. They are performing a mission even now."

Fortunately, the prophet Anna Croft and Asuka Ren seemed to be alive as well. Having roughly looked around the fortress, I thought it was time to gradually ask the important questions.

"You are curious about what happened during that time, right?"

As if reading my mind, Cha Yerin calmly began the story. The emergence of the existence now called 'Snow White' or 'Master of the Erased Blank Space'—'Snowfield Kim Dokja'. Clearing scenarios together with him. The companions dispersing according to their respective beliefs, and 'Ragnarok' beginning.

"I know that much roughly."

This was a story I knew to some extent through Snowfield Kim Dokja's story fragments or through other ways.

The important part was from here on.

"When Ragnarok began, there were incarnations who came to kill 'Snow White'."

"Ji Eunyu and the other incarnations, right?"

Cha Yerin nodded. Actually, I was reluctant to ask about that part in detail. Because her brother, Cha Seongwoo, had died in that battle. However, Cha Yerin calmly explained the events of that day. The companions turning against each other, and other constellations including <Eden> appearing on the battlefield. And—

"And <Kim Dokja's Company> descended upon this worldline."

I nodded. The part I wanted to hear had finally come.

"Where are they now? Did they really lose to 'Snow White'?"

Although I had received vague hints while talking with Ji Eunyu, I had no certain knowledge. However, I had to know now. Hesitating for a moment, Cha Yerin opened her mouth.

"I couldn't witness that scene myself."

Cha Yerin continued speaking with her head slightly bowed.

"However, I can tell you what happened. If you want—"

[I think I can tell you that story in detail.]

Turning around at the suddenly interrupting voice, the Supreme God of Light, Surya, was there. Perhaps having already finished rough treatment, his entire body was wrapped tightly in bandages.

[Are you curious about the survival of those 'Outer Gods'?]

Outer Gods. Certainly, to the stars of this world, they might appear that way.

"Yes."

[They are alive.]

I let out a sigh of relief internally. However, the questions were only beginning.

"I know that they clashed with 'Snow White'... the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space'."

[They did.]

"Did they lose?"

[A loss...]

Surya pondered for a moment, then spoke like this.

[I am not sure if it can be expressed that way.]

My heart raced for an instant. They didn't lose? That meant...

[The story of that day was truly amazing. Especially the sight shown by that 'Outer God wearing the black coat' is something I won't forget until my final moments.]

The Outer God wearing the black coat. Without needing to ask, it referred to Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,864th round. Surya had a somewhat hazy look in his eyes as if recalling that moment, and slowly added to his words.

[That day, the Outer God in the black coat drove the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space' to the brink of death.]

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< Episode 64. Eternal Night (5) > End

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1047 Episode 64. Eternal Night (6)

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At the brink of death. It wasn't any constellation but Surya who said it, then it must have been the truth.

It was the first time I heard about that day in detail, and not only the Kings who were with me but also Cha Yerin seemed to be listening attentively to Surya's story. After pausing for a moment to choose his words, Surya opened his mouth again.

[That overwhelming aura had never been witnessed before. I don't want to admit it, but he was higher than any 'Myth-grade' I had ever seen.]

[It wasn’t an opponent you could push back just because you have a higher status.]

It was Meihouwang, who had been listening to the story quietly, interrupting.

['The Master of the Erased Blank Space' wields absolute power. Even if the Outer God you mentioned was as powerful as you say, it would still have been extremely difficult to overcome it, wouldn’t it?]

The other Kings also nodded in agreement at Meihouwang’s words. It was a reasonable argument. Moreover, the Kings here had just experienced the power of that 'authority' firsthand. However, Surya shook his head and added.

[That Outer God was unaffected by the power used by 'The Master of the Erased Blank Space'.]

[Unaffected?]

The power of the Master of the Erased Blank Space.

「The power that expels one outside the context of this world by ceasing to 'read' a specific target.」

It seems like the power that only 'Oldest Dream' can use was used by Kim Dokja, even against Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,864th regression.

Surya, instead of giving an explanation, clenched his fist tightly and then opened it. Then, a small butterfly appeared in his palm. As the butterfly fluttered and began to fly, dust-like story powder fell from its wings. It was the story of that day Surya had preserved.

「"I will no longer read you."」

The familiar voice rang out from the story. With the true command of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', a sound like a book closing again in the story was heard. A merciless violence that denies the very page on which the existence is recorded and refuses to 'read', which no star could resist.

But there was a being who did not kneel before that power.

「"It's useless against me."」

A voice that sends shivers just by listening to it. Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,864th regression, who didn't hide his status, was there.

「He is the peak that the character Yoo Joonghyuk can reach.」

It was only upon seeing it that I realized the truth. A spirit ready to break through the story. An overwhelming presence that a person who has never given up for a moment and has overcome all of history can possess.

「"As long as you are 'Kim Dokja', that ability won’t work against me."」

In reality, Yoo Joonghyuk was approaching Kim Dokja one step at a time without taking any damage.

[How is that even—]

Meihouwang's eyes widened in disbelief. Even Abyssal Black Flame Dragon looked confused, as he couldn’t understand what happened. That was understandable. For them, this was the first time they had seen an 'Outer God' resist the power of the 'Oldest Dream'.

But that situation wasn't unfamiliar to me. If you think about it, it was natural. 'The Oldest Dream' is a being that lives while dreaming of something. And Kim Dokja became 'The Oldest Dream' by imagining the story of 'Yoo Joonghyuk', the protagonist of 'Ways of Survival'. In other words—not reading 'Yoo Joonghyuk' is no different from denying his identity as the 'Oldest Dream'.

「In the confrontation between the 'Secretive Plotter' and 'The Oldest Dream', something similar happened.」

The existence that could become the sole counter to the 'Oldest Dream' in this entire universe. That was none other than the protagonist, Yoo Joonghyuk.

「"I see."」

But Snowfield Kim Dokja wasn't confused. Instead, he smiled as if it were amusing and faced Yoo Joonghyuk.

「"Very well. Let’s fight properly."」

And thus, the battle began. Amidst the swirling of black and white stories before their eyes, an exchange of blows too fast to be tracked continued. The sound of blood spraying and flesh tearing proved that the two were engaged in a life-or-death duel.

[Giant Story, 'Demon Realm’s Spring', has begun its storytelling!]

[Giant Story, 'Torch That Swallowed the Myth', has begun its storytelling!]

As I watched the familiar stories clawing and baring their fangs at each other, pages of the original novel swirled in my mind.

Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Dokja had clashed many times. At the end of 'King's Road' facing 'The Absolute Throne'. In front of the 'Demon King’s Throne' where the Demon King of Salvation was born. In scenarios where they had to seize each other's 'Right to Life and Death' to ascend to the 'Context of the Constellations'. Besides those, the two had fought countlessly, countlessly many times.

「"Yoo Joonghyuk, have you forgotten? You cannot defeat me."」

With those words, a fierce spark erupted through the landscape.

['Stage Transformation' is activated!]

I understood what Snowfield Kim Dokja was plotting.

[Story, 'King of a Kingless World', has begun its storytelling!]

That was the birth story of Kim Dokja which existed in me as well. The eyes of Yoo Joonghyuk in the story shook as the stage was being reproduced before my eyes.

「There stood Gwanghwamun, where the two had once fought a bloody battle.」

The final chapter of 'King's Road'. In a scenario where only his own body can prove 'The King's Qualification', Kim Dokja temporarily surpassed Yoo Joonghyuk's stats by pouring coins.

「All stages strengthen the history that has already occurred.」

'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was the same. He used his coins to enhance all his physical attributes to their limits. Kim Dokja's fist, moving as fast as a shooting star, extended towards Yoo Joonghyuk.

「No matter how strong Yoo Joonghyuk is, he can't handle that punch right now.」

In the 'King’s Road' where neither skills nor stigmas can be used, Kim Dokja's fist struck Yoo Joonghyuk's abdomen.

Twokang!

Like an explosion, a blinding cloud of dust rose. According to the original story, Yoo Joonghyuk should have been sent flying from that punch. But Yoo Joonghyuk stood his ground. In fact, Kim Dokja's punch had been blocked by Yoo Joonghyuk's palm.

「"Did you really believe that you could defeat me with just this much?"」

For the first time, a hint of surprise was visible on Snowfield Kim Dokja's face. When had it started? Kim Dokja's stage, which had been dominating everything, had begun to crumble. Along with the surging sparks, a landscape of another 'stage' flickered.

The surrounding constellations were confused about what was happening, but I alone understood the situation.

「He is offsetting 'Stage Transformation' with 'Stage Transformation'.」

Kim Dokja's fights with Yoo Joonghyuk may have been won more often by Kim Dokja, but there were also many cases where the outcome wasn't properly decided, and sometimes—

['Stage Transformation' is activated!]

There were also cases where Yoo Joonghyuk won. Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Dokja stood facing each other in the rushing landscape. And I, too, was momentarily present in that landscape with them.

「"'I'll kill you, Yoo Joonghyuk.' Do you remember this line?"」

[Demon King Transformation] activated, a pale deadly aura radiated from Snowfield Kim Dokja's entire body. The corpses of stars scattered around them. I knew where that was.

「"I remember."」

The Isle of Reincarnators. Here, Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Dokja had fought.

「"Back then, you killed Han Sooyoung."」

A pure white blade was shining in the hand of Snowfield Kim Dokja. 'Unbreakable Faith'. Kim Dokja's main weapon.

「"I knew she wouldn't die."」

「"Did you fight me knowing that? Why?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer. Kim Dokja smiled faintly.

「"You never know how to speak properly. That is why Han Sooyoung ultimately died."」

「"Han Sooyoung is not dead."」

「"No, she's dead. Because of you. Because you were stubborn—"」

Snowfield Kim Dokja's figure vanished. Accelerated through [Electrification], he swung his sword towards Yoo Joonghyuk's head.

「"Because you never gave up on the meaningless goal of finding 'every Kim Dokja'!"」

Yoo Joonghyuk swung the [Black Heavenly Demon Sword] to block Kim Dokja's strikes.

「"That was also Han Sooyoung's goal."」

「"Then why didn't you step forward in her place first?"」

「"That's—"」

Snowfield Kim Dokja kept swinging his sword relentlessly, without leaving any room for Yoo Joonghyuk to answer.

「"She is the person who writes the lines for the characters. You already knew that, didn't you? That Han Sooyoung would act in your place and fulfill what you wanted. That one-sided belief of yours—"」

The black and white blades roared as they clashed. No star dared to interfere in their duel. Even the stars that shattered planets and dominated galaxies looked at their battle with awe.

「"—is what drove Han Sooyoung to her death."」

Yoo Joonghyuk's sword hesitated for a fraction of a second, and Snowfield Kim Dokja did not miss the opportunity. Shaking Yoo Joonghyuk with his tongue, Snowfield Kim Dokja unleashed truly astonishing sword strikes. The skills and stories he gained while living through the scenarios were embedded in every trajectory. Although it was slightly different from Kim Dokja’s fighting style that I remembered, he was undoubtedly a Kim Dokja who had been perfected throughout the scenario.

「The stage they shared crossed over in an instant.」

They were on the 'King’s Road', in the Demon Realm, in the Context of the Constellations, and in the Great War of Saints and Demons. In the moment a star was born, all of that history flowed by, and their swords clashed.

Stories sprayed from Yoo Joonghyuk's thigh. In the moment his center collapsed, Kim Dokja's sword came down.

「If it were the old Yoo Joonghyuk, he might have lost to Kim Dokja here.」

However, Yoo Joonghyuk blocked even that sword. With his usual calm expression, he parried the lethal strike without any agitation.

['Stage Transformation' becomes even stronger!]

At the same time, the bright light of [Lotus Pedestal] filled the area. Snowfield Kim Dokja stiffened upon realizing Yoo Sangah's intervention.

「On the Isle of Reincarnators, Yoo Joonghyuk succeeds in cutting down Kim Dokja's [The Fourth Wall].」

In an instant, the Stage Transformation was further strengthened as Yoo Joonghyuk's muscles swelled. Yoo Joonghyuk's [Black Heavenly Demon Sword] blazed.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship.

That was not the Dark Ocean Slash which cut the sea, nor the Meteor Strike which cut down stars. It was simply the swordsmanship containing the history accumulated by Yoo Joonghyuk. Along with the sensation as if the trajectory of the universe itself twisted, the sound of Snowfield Kim Dokja's wrist and knee bones dislocating rang out.

'Unbreakable Faith' rolled on the ground, and Kim Dokja, having lost his balance, fell to one knee. Snowfield Kim Dokja lifted his head with a dazed expression. Yoo Joonghyuk spoke.

「"It's over."」

The tip of the Black Heavenly Demon Sword aimed at his throat. Finally, the battle was decided.

[All stars of <Star Stream> are intoxicated with fierce excitement!]

[All stars of <Star Stream> will never forget this moment for a long time!]

The one who uses the power of the 'Oldest Dream', and thus the Kim Dokja closest to the 'Oldest Dream' in this world. A being who subdued such a Kim Dokja had been born.

However, Yoo Joonghyuk did not seem pleased at all. He opened his mouth with his eyes narrowed.

「"Why didn't you use the power of the 'Oldest Dream' further?"」

Then, Snowfield Kim Dokja smiled.

「"It doesn't work against you anyway."」

「"There were other targets you could have used it on."」

As Yoo Joonghyuk said. Even if the ability of the 'Oldest Dream' didn't work against Yoo Joonghyuk, it didn't mean the same for others. Snowfield Kim Dokja could have captured his companions and used them as hostages, or even wiped out this entire stage. But Snowfield Kim Dokja didn't do that. He fought only with the full power he had as 'Kim Dokja'.

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly lowered his sword as he looked down on Snowfield Kim Dokja.

「"That’s enough playing around. Let’s go back now."」

But Snowfield Kim Dokja shook his head.

「"The person you are supposed to take is not me."」

「"You are Kim Dokja."」

Snowfield Kim Dokja quietly looked up at Yoo Joonghyuk. For a moment, it seemed as if countless emotions passed over Snowfield's eyes. He seemed to feel gratitude, sadness, and also a deep sense of betrayal and humiliation.

「"If I had truly been Kim Dokja, you wouldn’t have been able to defeat me."」

At least at that moment, he didn't seem like Kim Dokja. He was the 'Snow White' admired by disasters, and the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space' feared by stars.

「"If you don't come with me, I'll cut you down."」

「"You won't be able to do it."」

Yoo Joonghyuk, whose eyebrows twitched, raised his sword to prove his words. From afar, he heard Yoo Sangah shouting something. But Yoo Joonghyuk's sword didn't hesitate.

「"Didn't I say so?"」

And just as Yoo Joonghyuk's sword was about to reach Kim Dokja's shoulder.

Tzzzzzt!

A powerful spark erupted in the air.

「"You can't do it."」

Yoo Joonghyuk's blade was stopped exactly on top of Kim Dokja's shoulder. Fiercely surging stories were protecting Kim Dokja from his sword. Yoo Joonghyuk, startled, looked at the story that had repelled his blade.

「"This is..."」

Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes filled with deep distrust as he confirmed the trace of someone flowing in Kim Dokja's story.

「"That cannot be."」

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< Episode 64. Eternal Night (6) > End

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1048 Episode 64. Eternal Night (7)

It was the first time seeing such an expression on Yoo Joonghyuk. When Kim Dokja, whom he thought was dead, revived for the first time—perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk had an expression like the one now.

The story protecting Kim Dokja's shoulder repelled Yoo Joonghyuk's sword.

「"If that is an 'avatar', there is a very easy way to verify it."」

Spewing out a very old story, the story cried out sorrowfully.

「The dagger accurately grazed the nape of Kim Dokja's shoulder.」

That was a story that had once cut Kim Dokja's shoulder. I too knew what that story was. That was the core story proving the 49% Kim Dokja.

「"The guy who will read my novel isn't you."」

The voice of someone missed flowed past the ears.

「"You'll know if you cut off the head. Because an avatar moves even if you cut off its head."」

It was the voice of the person who wanted Kim Dokja more than anyone else. The voice of the person who had longed for a single reader for longer than anyone else, and thus had written down his words in place of Yoo Joonghyuk.

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at Snowfield Kim Dokja with wavering eyes.

「"How did you get this story..."」

A day everyone had dreamed of—it was a story created on a certain day after the hellish scenarios ended. The Han River that Yoosung-i had wanted to go to so much. A picnic with loved ones carrying chicken and pizza.

December 25th. That day a certain star was born—

「On that day, a certain Kim Dokja was born.」

The Kim Dokja who was denied himself. The Kim Dokja who could not properly remember 'Ways of Survival'—that Kim Dokja was 'discovered' on that day.

「Thus the owner of the story thought, 'What if I had not noticed that fact on that day.'」

A sentence imbued with deep regret and sadness. Neither Yoo Joonghyuk nor I could say anything at that moment as we read that sentence. A power that makes anyone into merely a reader. Such a power was inside that story.

「'If I had not cut Kim Dokja on that day, what would have happened to this story.'」

That was the birth story that created the 49% Kim Dokja.

[Story, 'Fake Kim Dokja', continues its storytelling.]

That story was neither my story nor Snowfield Kim Dokja's story. Yoo Joonghyuk spoke.

「"That is Han Sooyoung's story."」

The owner of that story was Han Sooyoung. The person who had noticed the 'Avatar Kim Dokja' before anyone else. The person who had doubted Kim Dokja first at the Han River on that day.

「Her story, which had been like that, was now protecting Snowfield Kim Dokja.」

As if telling them not to repeat any more mistakes, the story cried fiercely. Before the story, <Kim Dokja Company> was seen collapsing.

Yoo Joonghyuk muttered.

「"Why."」

Snowfield Kim Dokja laughed.

「"Do you really not know? Why this story is protecting me."」

Along with those words, once again a story flickered from Snowfield Kim Dokja's entire body.

[Story, 'Fake Kim Dokja', continues its storytelling.]

Han Sooyoung's story was harbored in Snowfield Kim Dokja and grew together with him. Turned away by companions time and again, the story grew and grew.

「I'll be abandoned anyway. Because I'm not the 'Kim Dokja' you want.」

The history that created the him of today was recorded there. <Kim Dokja Company> wandering while searching for the 'real Kim Dokja', leaving him behind. Even among them, there was one related to the 'third Kim Dokja'.

「Despite the calling of Snowfield Kim Dokja, <Kim Dokja Company> did not descend upon the world of the third.」

Only then did I fully understand what the 'Snowfield Fragment' had said to me. To strengthen that story, Snowfield Kim Dokja had not hesitated to be hurt all along. Moreover, it was not only <Kim Dokja Company> that hurt him.

「"You don't seem to be the Kim Dokja I knew."」

The readers who loved this story more than anyone. Even the readers who cleared scenarios together with him did not accept Snowfield as the 'Kim Dokja' they knew.

Hurt like that and accepting those wounds, Snowfield Kim Dokja came all the way here. Waiting solely for this moment to use this 'story' against <Kim Dokja Company>.

「"I can't go to 'that house' anyway. Because what you want isn't me. Even if I go, you will live longing for Kim Dokja once again. Longing forever for the Kim Dokja you couldn't find, the Kim Dokja you wanted to find."」

As if denying those words, Yoo Joonghyuk moved his sword once again. However, his [Black Heavenly Demon Sword] did not budge on top of Kim Dokja's shoulder.

Something was sealing Yoo Joonghyuk's movements. It was Snowfield's story.

「Can a mere single story block the sword of the Supreme King feared by all stars.」

No star whatsoever would fear that story. However, Yoo Joonghyuk was different. Looking at Yoo Joonghyuk's trembling hand, Snowfield Kim Dokja slowly rose from his spot. Then, pushing away Yoo Joonghyuk's blade with the back of his hand, he spoke.

「"So stop talking about home now. Instead, go to the conclusion of this world together with me."」

Along with Snowfield Kim Dokja's voice, stories overflowed from within him. Inside the storm of raging stories, Snowfield Kim Dokja seemed to say something. Or perhaps he seemed to show something he possessed. However, because the storm was too fierce, that scene could not be properly verified from Surya's location. What was heard was the shock of <Kim Dokja Company>.

「"How, this—"」

「"■■■, how, no!—"」

「"Stop! ■■■!"」

Surya's story was up to there. Having fulfilled its duty, Surya's butterfly lost its strength and scattered in the air. Me, the other Kings, and Cha Yerin as well. We silently gazed at the spot where the butterfly had disappeared.

Amidst countless emotions crossing, I opened my mouth first.

"Is this all?"

Surya nodded.

"What happened to <Kim Dokja Company> after that? The Master of the Erased Blank Space..."

Surya frowned with a solemn face, then answered slowly.

['The Master of the Erased Blank Space' disappeared from the battlefield together with the Outer Gods he bound. And...]

Surya clenched his fist tightly once more. Then this time, a moth with pitch-black wings appeared.

[The war between the 'disasters' following him and the stars began.]

Following the dust scattered by the moth that took flight, the story of that day unfolded. A story where stars were dying and disasters were screaming. A horrific scenery forged by the main battlefield of 'Ragnarok'. However, nowhere on that battlefield were the appearances of Snowfield Kim Dokja or <Kim Dokja Company> to be seen.

The moth soon fulfilled its lifespan and scattered. Looking at the disappearing moth, I asked once again.

"What about the other Myth-grade constellations? What were they doing?"

Something suddenly came to mind. When first entering the 'Main Battlefield', I had briefly encountered the constellations of <Emperor> who had turned into anomalous entities.

"<Olympus>, <Asgard>, <Vedas>, and <Emperor>. They wouldn't have been just watching everything, right?"

Surya nodded. Especially when mentioning the name of <Vedas>, his expression looked a bit painful.

[They too challenged the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space' in their own ways. They...]

Surya ultimately could not convey the remaining words. With a tzzzt spark sound, his incarnation body collapsed. It was because he revealed too much of his story while his wounds were not properly healed yet.

"You can stop speaking. You overexerted yourself too much."

Cha Yerin supported the stumbling Surya. Medics were seen running from afar. As Cha Yerin said, sending Surya to rest at this point was right. However, I could not stop asking questions. Because I had not heard an important fact.

"Are there stars among them who are still alive?"

Whether Surya was in a state of fading consciousness, there was no response. The one who answered instead was Cha Yerin.

"There are."

"Who is it?"

After entrusting Surya to the medics, Cha Yerin spoke in a calm voice.

"'One-eyed Father' or 'Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Sea'... The representative constellations of each nebula are still alive in some way."

"Are they in this camp right now?"

Cha Yerin nodded heavily. Frankly speaking, after hearing up to that point, my head felt dizzy.

[No, to think the battlefield is in this state even though those bastards are alive!]

As if venting anger on my behalf, Meihouwang erupted with a rough True Voice.

[Where are those fellows!]

"By now, they must all be in the situation room."

We headed straight for the situation room. The situation room Cha Yerin mentioned was in an open area inside the inner castle that had become ruins after receiving shellings. However, when opening the tent of the situation room and entering, what was waiting for us was an empty scene.

[These damn fellows...]

Traces of someone having been there until a moment ago remained everywhere. Peels of discarded sacred fruits, broken recorder pieces, and implements carved with who-knows-what.

I quietly raised my energy sensing. However, nowhere in the vicinity could the presence of a 'Myth-grade constellation' be felt. Knowing that the Kings and I were coming, those fellows had already turned tail and fled.

Letting out a light sigh, I shook my head.

"What about other forces? Surely these aren't all of them."

Even if the fight of the 'Main Battlefield' was arduous, there should still be quite a few stars remaining. No matter how many stars had set, no matter how powerful the disasters over there were—there was no way every single star I knew had truly set.

"What about Goryeo's First Sword? There should be other constellations of the Korean Peninsula as well."

Cheok Jungyeong. A star more upright than any constellation I knew, and a master who had also taught me in the Fear Realm. There was no way he died here.

"Where is the God of Wine and Ecstasy? Surely there must be other representative constellations of the 'Constellation Camp'."

I recalled the judges of the Underworld and Baccarinne who had come to see me in the 'preliminary battle'. They said they were following the new ruler of the Underworld, the 'God of Wine and Ecstasy'—Dionysus.

"Surely the Transcendents fought together as well?"

I recalled the Transcendents I knew. Although Breaking the Sky Sword Saint Namgung Minyoung was caught in the constellations' scheme in the 'New Murim District', many powerful Transcendents still remained. The constellation met in the preliminary battle—Sun Hunter 'Hou Yi' must have also come up to this battlefield to find his friends.

"Where is Master Kyrgios?"

Cha Yerin was silent for a moment. Looking at me with pupils whose emotion could not be read, she spoke in a small voice.

"Follow me."

All throughout following Cha Yerin, I felt an unidentifiable ominousness. Cha Yerin's footsteps exited the inner castle and headed toward the outer edge of the outer castle. I felt incarnations who occasionally discovered us blankly gazing over here. Many of them were missing an arm or a leg. Empty pupils where neither hope nor despair could be felt. Those gazes were following us.

How long did we walk like that? We finally arrived in front of a white building on the outer edge of the outer castle.

"Are they in here?"

Cha Yerin nodded slightly. Without hesitating, I entered inside the building. Was it because of the color of the building? I initially thought that place was a sort of ward. However, the moment I entered inside the building, I realized.

「This place is not a ward.」

In that place, small tombstones were erected in numbers beyond counting.

「The charnel house of stars was there.」

Tombstones so numerous as to be dizzying. In front of the tombstones engraved with modifiers were the star relics used by the tombstones' owners.

I stood in front of a broken sword whose shape was familiar among them. On the tombstone placed next to the sword, it was written like this.

「The great star of the Korean Peninsula, Goryeo's First Sword Cheok Jungyeong—rests in this scenario.」

I read that sentence again several times. Goryeo's First Sword Cheok Jungyeong. Goryeo's First Sword... Cheok Jungyeong.

「I remembered him.」

The sight of him laughing boisterously, the moment he came to save me, the way he brandished his sword—I remembered it all.

I continued walking. In the charnel house, there were not only the remains of stars.

「King of the North, Magician Jacob Martinez—rests in this scenario.」

「Castle Lord of Paradise, Reinheit von Dserba—rests in this scenario.」

The names of incarnations I knew were written in that place.

「Indomitable Fighter, Eternal Emperor Fei Hu—rests in this scenario.」

Incarnations who struggled until the end without giving up against disasters. And at the end of that long list, a sentence I knew well was written.

「The smallest is the greatest.」

It felt as if my breath was suffocating. Nevertheless, I had to read that sentence. Without reading that sentence—

「The one who proved his beliefs with his life. The Transcendent who protected the final defensive line longer than anyone else.」

Because I could never move on to the next sentence.

「Paradox of White Purity, Kyrgios Rodgraim—rests in this scenario.」

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< Episode 64. Eternal Night (7) > End

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1049 Episode 64. Eternal Night (8)

I read the sentence written on Kyrgios's tombstone again and again. I kept reading it until the words almost lost their meaning.

「Kyrgios Rodgraim has died.」

When I blinked, the form of the record floating before my eyes shifted.

「Goryeo's First Sword Cheok Jungyeong has died.」

As if forcing me to accept that reality before I could move forward, the records continued to surface in front of me.

I left Kyrgios's monument and examined the other tombstones. Among the gravestones of the Transcendents were those I knew well—beings I had met in the 'Realm of Fear'.

「The Strongest Transcendent, Unrivaled One-Fist Yu Hoseong — rests in this scenario.」

The Commander of the 0th Division of the Transcendent Alliance. The master of both Kyrgios and the Saint of Breaking the Sky, Unrivaled One-Fist Yu Hoseong. He, too, had met his end on this battlefield.

Cha Yerin, who had been watching me from the side, spoke softly.

"Everyone is dead."

It felt as though the air in this world was rapidly thinning. The ceiling of the ossuary was wide open, like the colosseum from the preliminary battle. Looking up at the open sky, I felt acutely that stars were not the only things that had vanished from this world.

「That overwhelming sorrow made me oddly calm instead.」

Perhaps it was at that very moment that I realized the role I was truly meant to play in this story. Looking endlessly up at the vast blank space stretching out before me, I listened to her voice.

"Everyone... they're all dead."

Turning my head, my remaining reader was looking at me.

"Writer-nim."

"Yes."

I knew what Cha Yerin's desperate expression meant. I knew what she expected of me. There are people who spend their lives reading a story, loving and cherishing its characters. And readers who have lost those characters usually wear the exact same expression.

"As you know, it's impossible for dead characters to come back to life."

"But this is the <Star Stream>."

That was true. Fortunately, this world was the <Star Stream>. A world where resurrection was possible. A world where, as long as the soul remained intact, one could somehow push through sheer impossibility. Running various possibilities through my mind, I asked calmly:

"Does the <Underworld> still exist in this world? I heard the God of Wine and Ecstasy became the new master of the <Underworld>."

At the mention of the <Underworld>, Cha Yerin's complexion darkened slightly.

"The <Underworld> has become so ruined that its very existence can no longer be sustained. <Olympus> drew probability through the <Underworld> for their final battle."

As expected, damn <Olympus> is never helpful.

"And the God of Wine and Ecstasy went missing in a battle a few weeks ago."

It was truly the worst possible situation. The <Underworld> was destroyed, and its master was missing. Yet, something about Cha Yerin's story left a lingering question in my mind. Could the <Underworld> really fall so easily? It had the Gigantes, and those formidable figures Hades and Persephone. In the first place, how had Dionysus inherited the <Underworld>? Where had Hades and Persephone disappeared to?

"It's probably not just <Olympus>—the underworlds belonging to other nebulae are likely in a similar state."

I nodded in agreement. If <Olympus>'s <Underworld> was destroyed, the netherworlds of other nebulae had surely met a similar fate. Even the Three Sovereigns and Five Emperors of <Emperor> had fallen into such a state; no nebula could remain unscathed.

"I see."

Without an underworld, souls could not be retrieved. In other words, resurrection through the netherworld was impossible.

"Um—"

"It's alright, Yerin-ssi."

Even so, I answered composedly.

"I'll figure something out. Don't worry."

Cha Yerin's eyes trembled at my words. I offered her a faint smile and turned back to look at my masters' tombstones one last time. Then, together with Cha Yerin, I left the ossuary. As we stepped out and looked back at the entrance, a thought suddenly crossed my mind.

"Who built this ossuary?"

"I heard it was one of the Recorders of Fear."

I checked the small sign hanging at the entrance of the ossuary.

「Eternal Night」

That was the name of this ossuary.

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Night fell. That was merely a way of expressing the passage of time—in truth, the world had been in perpetual night all day. Because even the 'God of Supreme Light' Surya was too heavily injured, there was no star left to bring forth the day.

I sat alone inside the command tent. The command tent also had an open ceiling. Both here and the ossuary—most of the structures in this city had open roofs. Whether they were built that way from the beginning or deliberately opened later, I couldn't tell.

Perhaps someone had designed them like this to count the stars in the night sky. If so, it was a terrible, morbid taste. Because right now, the night sky of the <Star Stream> was nothing more than a death register. The stars recorded in that sky were bound to fall. That was the preordained end of this world.

Unable to sleep, Jung Heewon poked her head carefully through the tent flap.

"May I come in?"

"Of course."

Offering a faint smile, Jung Heewon pulled up a chair beside me. We sat quietly, staring at the table between us. On the table lay pieces carved by Odin. At first, they were hard to recognize, but looking closely, the pieces were miniature carvings representing the symbols of various constellations.

I picked up a carved piece shaped like a lightning hammer. This one clearly represented Thor. Thor's piece was broken. It didn't look like someone had smashed it—it seemed to have been carved broken from the start. Realizing that, the other pieces on the table looked completely different. Perhaps all these carvings were tombstones of constellations created by Odin.

Staring at the broken handle of Thor's hammer, Jung Heewon asked:

"Will Yerin-ssi be alright?"

When we entered the ossuary, Jung Heewon and the other Kings had stepped aside to give Cha Yerin and me some privacy.

"She won't be."

"I thought so..."

Jung Heewon's expression wasn't bright either. She too must have found names she recognized in the ossuary. After all, she was the disciple of the Saint of Breaking the Sky, one of the leaders of the Transcendent Alliance.

"The Transcendent commanders... are they really all dead?"

"As of now, yes."

Hearing my response, Jung Heewon blinked blankly before asking again:

"Pardon?"

"It means there might be a way."

There is no <Underworld> left in this world. But just because there is no <Underworld> doesn't mean resurrection is impossible. Above all, I had once stayed in a world under similar circumstances.

'Demon King of Salvation.'

The moment I summoned the eldest in my mind, a reply came back instantly.

- Yeah.

'Have you tried contacting the Lump-bearing King?'

Right after leaving the ossuary, I called upon my brothers inside the [Fourth Wall] and asked them for a few favors.

- I'm still trying. But there's no answer yet.

'Have you reviewed the method I mentioned?'

- Reviewed it? Can I be honest with you?

'Of course.'

- I think it's a completely insane method.

I let out a dry laugh and replied:

'Has Kim Dokja ever cleared a scenario using a normal method?'

I threw it out as a joke, but the Demon King of Salvation's response was dead serious.

- It's going to cost a truly monstrous amount of probability. You know that, right?

'Probability doesn't matter. But it's worth considering, right?'

- You're probably the only one who could ever think of a method like this.

'Let me know when you're ready.'

- Until then, don't die.

That was the end of the conversation. Letting out a light sigh, I checked the system messages I had put off reviewing. Although we were lucky to win the first defense battle without major losses, the real problem started now.

[You are currently the 'Commander' of this fortress.]

The commander of a fortress is automatically appointed as the 'highest-status existence' within the fortress. My becoming the commander meant there was currently no Myth-grade constellation with higher status than me inside this fortress.

It was then that a small noise came from the entrance of the command tent.

[Hmm, you're already here?]

The worn tent entrance rustled as the 'Mass-Production Maker', the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', and 'Meihouwang' appeared. Judging by their expressions, the three hadn't exactly planned this visit together. Likely, they had all become lost in thought, just like Jung Heewon.

They each took a seat around the table. The Mass-Production Maker spoke first.

[I couldn't sleep, so I thought I'd drop by.]

"Don't constellations usually not sleep?"

[Nonsense! Even I sleep from time to time. As you get older, getting enough sleep is the only way to slow down the aging of your Fable.]

I let out a small chuckle. The Mass-Production Maker's reason for coming was clear. He was worried about the heavy responsibility I must be feeling alone. And the other

constellations were likely here for similar reasons.

Meihouwang, who had been glaring at me with dissatisfied eyes, spoke up as if he had been waiting.

[When tomorrow comes, the next battlefield will open.]

"Presumably."

[Now that they know we've joined this side, the Disaster Camp won't attempt a reckless siege with small forces anymore.]

I nodded. But Meihouwang, thinking I hadn't fully grasped the gravity of it, continued:

[I'm saying we won't be as lucky next time. It would be fortunate if only one 'Interstellar Devourer' comes, but in all likelihood—]

[At least five or six Interstellar Devourers. Or something even worse.]

At the Mass-Production Maker's words, a deep silence fell over the table. It was clear who 'something even worse' referred to.

"The Aberration of the Emperor."

At my words, Meihouwang's lips twitched as he said:

[If that monster comes, even I won't be able to stop it. Honestly, I don't think the four of us combined could win against it. And in the worst-case scenario...]

"If it's the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space', I will handle him somehow."

[You truly intend to fight him.]

"That's why I came all the way here, isn't it?"

Did they sense a certain conviction in my tone? For a moment, the three Kings wore peculiar expressions and looked at one another. The Mass-Production Maker smiled faintly and spoke:

[According to intelligence received by the flagship, even excluding the Aberration of the Emperor, the identified number of Interstellar Devourers is at least twenty.]

Interstellar Devourers were Outer Gods equivalent to 'Natural Catastrophe Class' in the Recorder of Fear's classification. The enemy side had at least twenty such Outer Gods. Considering that each of them was a monster on par with a Myth-grade constellation, the power imbalance was utterly despairing.

[And there's one more thing. Aside from the 'Aberration of the Emperor', there is another concern.]

I felt like I already knew what the Mass-Production Maker was going to say.

"<Kim Dokja Company>."

The Mass-Production Maker nodded heavily. Currently, <Kim Dokja Company> had been abducted by Snowfield Kim Dokja. While Snowfield Kim Dokja certainly possessed counter-Fables against <Kim Dokja Company>, if <Kim Dokja Company> had truly intended to resist, escaping that place would have been possible. Yet <Kim Dokja Company> had chosen to be bound by Snowfield Kim Dokja instead of escaping.

[If by any chance those Outer Gods take the side of the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space', frankly speaking, we have zero chance of victory.]

It was true. If <Kim Dokja Company> stood on Snowfield Kim Dokja's side, it would create a situation just as despairing as all 999th regression disasters siding with the 'Dokkaebi King' in the main novel.

[We came all this way because we believe in you, but frankly, the situation is grim. Even if you miraculously hold off the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space', we lack the military strength to face the remaining forces.]

"You don't need to worry too much about that part."

[Hmm? Do you have another ally?]

"It's about time they arrived."

[Who?]

"The constellations who don't want to die."

Along with my words, the sound of approaching footsteps echoed outside the tent. Meihouwang, who had his senses heightened, abruptly stood up from his seat.

[You bastards—]

Opening the tent, two Myth-grade constellations appeared. 'Poseidon', the Spear Drawing the Boundary of Seas from <Olympus>, and 'Odin', the One-Eyed Father from <Asgard>.

Poseidon spoke first.

[I heard reinforcements arrived. Are you lot all of them?]

He looked flushed, as though he had been drinking somewhere. Drunk out of his mind, he tipped another gulp of alcohol into his mouth and spoke mockingly:

[Nothing but half-baked runts.]

[You bastard... Do you want to be eternally extinguished?]

Meihouwang released his status, his voice booming with true command, but Poseidon didn't pay him the slightest attention.

[So you are the adversary of the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space'.]

Slumping down before the table like a ruffian, Poseidon stared fixedly at me. Looking at his intoxicated face, the fragment of Poseidon I had met in the Third's world came to mind.

[You are too late. No matter what you do now, the stars can no longer defeat the disaster.]

[Did you come all the way here just to say such trash? Aren't you the ones who caused this situation in the first place?]

At Poseidon's shameless demeanor, Meihouwang was on the verge of exploding. Glancing at Meihouwang, Poseidon chuckled bitterly and replied:

[That's right. It's all my fault. Everything is due to the greed of us damn Myth-grade constellations. I have no intention of denying it.]

His face showed neither the overbearing aura of one who carved out the boundaries of the ocean at will, nor the arrogance of refusing to allow any star above his horizon. All that could be felt from him was powerlessness—an intensely deep and heavy sense of helplessness.

Disliking Poseidon's attitude, Meihouwang frowned and spat out:

[With what nerve does a guy who ran away without even putting up a proper fight show up here?]

Instead of answering Meihouwang, Poseidon looked at me.

[You must know. The reason I came here.]

Instead of answering, I looked back at Poseidon.

「Constellations. Beings who wish to witness the end of the story they love, even if it means burning away everything they possess.」

Perhaps this star had come to witness the end of everything—including himself.

[A message arrived from the terminal left behind by Hermes.]

As if pronouncing the time of doom for this worldline, Poseidon's lips slowly parted.

[Tomorrow, the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space' will descend here.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1050 Episode 65. The Last Banquet (1)

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[He's coming here tomorrow? Is that true?]

Meihouwang, who had previously shown nothing but hatred toward Poseidon, expressed a completely different emotion for the first time. The Mass-Production Maker, who immediately verified the source of the information beside him, nodded meaningfully.

[Has Hermes's network still been functioning? Upon checking, the information seems to be true.]

At the Mass-Production Maker's confirmation, Jung Heewon composed her breathing as if tense, and Meihouwang's expression turned far more serious. On the other hand, there was one fellow who was inexplicably triumphant all by himself.

[Good. Is it finally time for me to spread my wings?]

As the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon puffed out his chest and muttered, Meihouwang snapped at him in disbelief:

[You stupid demon dragon! If the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space' descends here tomorrow, your damn wings will be torn off before you can even spread them!]

[What are you talking about? I just need to become the Apocalypse Dragon.]

[Do you think becoming the Apocalypse Dragon is that easy? And this is 'Ragnarok', you idiot!]

The Abyssal Black Flame Dragon glared lightly at the growling Meihouwang, then looked toward me as if feeling wronged. Come to think of it, I had promised to make the 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon' into the Apocalypse Dragon.

[A banquet before doom, and nothing but fools have gathered.]

Chuckling softly, Poseidon shook his head in amusement and spread his palm over the table. Instantly, the scent of the sea wafted in, and the scenery on the table changed.

[Eat and drink. For this will be your last banquet.]

The table was filled with a lavish feast fit for constellations. There were dishes made from rare elixirs like Sacred Fruit, Thousand-Year Snow Ginseng, and Ten-Thousand-

Year Fleeceflower, as well as ingredients representing each nebula like 'Soma' and 'Amrita'. And that wasn't all.

「Terrine of Minotaur Front Hoof」

「Steamed Thick Hydra Cheeks」

「Siren Fin Soup」

Looking at dishes prepared from parts of mythical creatures, the Kings let out small groans. Terrine made from Minotaur meat and steamed Hydra cheeks. On top of that, soup topped with crispy fried Siren fins... These were dishes that could only be prepared in <Olympus>.

[What kind of scheme is this?]

When Meihouwang asked with a scowl, Poseidon chuckled and replied:

[Literally. Enjoy your last supper.]

I stared down silently at the food Poseidon had brought out. Perhaps these were dishes meant to be served at the table of the <Round Table>. Poseidon's intention was clear. Like the final meal given to condemned prisoners, since these dishes would be useless by tomorrow anyway, he was dumping them on us instead.

I picked up a piece of the Minotaur terrine in front of me and put it in my mouth.

"It's delicious."

At my reaction, Meihouwang opened his mouth in disbelief. Regardless, I continued eating. I ate the Hydra cheeks and the Siren fins. Mythical creatures that had likely been farmed by constellations. I ate while faithfully imagining their Fables.

Staring at me eating casually, Poseidon's eyes flickered. I offered a faint smile and asked:

"What? You said it's the last supper, didn't you? We have to eat well to fight well."

Hearing my words, Jung Heewon also picked up her chopsticks, as if coming to a realization. Taking a slice of the terrine and tasting it, she exclaimed in admiration:

"It really is delicious."

"Right?"

"It's completely different from the terrine eaten at funerals."

"I suppose that's because it's a funeral for stars."

At that, the Mass-Production Maker beside us also poked at the food with his fork.

[Hmm, where was this Hydra farmed? The marbling level seems quite high.]

Meihouwang also seemed to come to a decision, tearing wildly at the Minotaur front leg in front of him while muttering:

[Crazy bastards.]

For someone spouting rough curses, his appetite was remarkably vigorous. Following him, the Abyssal Black Flame Dragon also nibbled on the dessert made of Sacred Fruit in front of him.

Watching us actually enjoying the banquet, Poseidon narrowed his eyes and spat out:

[Have you all lost your minds right before the final act? Tomorrow, the <Star Stream> ends. Every Fable in this world could reach its conclusion.]

With the last supper laid out before them, how many condemned prisoners could truly enjoy the feast? But the five gathered here were precisely the kind of lunatics capable of doing such a thing.

"So what?"

[What?]

"We've always come this far thinking we might die today."

The scenarios were always hell. Ever since the very first scenario. Suddenly, every human's remaining lifespan became 30 minutes, which soon shrank to 10 minutes. During those 10 minutes, all who failed to prove their worth died. Kim Dokja—and I—had lived through such a story every single time.

"If destruction is tomorrow, we actually have plenty of time. Don't we?"

Poseidon sat blankly without replying, watching us eat the food. Seeing me scoop up Hydra cheek meat over red soup and eat it, Jung Heewon made a comment:

"Eating it like that makes it look like gukbap."

"Ah, gukbap calls for a glass of soju. Right?"

"Exactly. Hey, fish mister over there. Pass us any leftover alcohol if you have some."

Having even his drink snatched away unexpectedly, Poseidon stared at us with dazed eyes.

Jung Heewon, I, and the three Kings ate and drank until we were full. The dishes served by high-ranking constellations at their own banquets naturally couldn't be anything less than delicious. Until we finished our meal, Poseidon remained silent.

Looking at Poseidon, who was blankly staring at a corner of the table, I spoke:

"It's pitiful."

Snapping his head up, Poseidon glared at me as if asking what I meant.

"I find it pitiful that you can't put anything in your mouth because you're too worried about tomorrow's destruction, even with a feast right in front of you."

[You punk, are you mocking me now—]

"Why did you drink? You can't even get drunk anyway. No matter how much your status has fallen, there's no alcohol capable of getting a Myth-grade constellation drunk."

It wasn't just Poseidon; the same applied to me and the other Kings. We drank, but with status at our level, there was no way alcohol would get us drunk.

"Why? Now that it's time to die, did you feel like playing human?"

Poseidon looking intoxicated wasn't because of alcohol. The only thing that can intoxicate a star is a story. He was merely drunk on the overwhelming Fable of the approaching final act.

[Yeah. It seems so.]

At his unexpectedly honest answer, I let out a dry laugh. It felt like I might actually be able to talk to the current Poseidon.

"You were like that in that world, too."

[That world?]

Poseidon asked back reflexively before his expression stiffened. Even without my explanation, he realized on his own. Which world I was referring to.

"Having lost everything, you were just like an ordinary old man."

Poseidon opened his eyes wide in slight surprise, then grimaced and avoided my gaze.

[It must have been an eyesore of a pathetic sight.]

I remembered Poseidon trapped in the 'Third's World'. Holding a recorder in his hand, wearing a marine cap.

"No, it wasn't. Above all, you in that world never gave up until the very end. Even while captured by the Great Sage Heaven's Equal, you kept watching for a chance to escape. Even after losing all your status and becoming a ordinary old man, you never lost your pride as a once-great star."

The Poseidon of that world had spirit. Even while being mocked by enemies with status far lower than his, when the only miracle he could perform was spouting strong water from his mouth, he never gave up resisting until the very end.

[What are you trying to say?]

"There must be a reason why you were the last to survive among the stars of damn <Olympus>."

[What do you know—]

"You definitely fought hard, didn't you?"

[.....]

"Because an arrogant constellation like you, a 'Spear Drawing the Boundary of Seas' whose pride would rather choose death over defeat, survived even in that state because you still had stories left that you wanted to see."

Now I could see it. What dwelt in his intoxicated eyes wasn't despair.

"You are still dreaming of a miracle. That's why you play human every day and drink alcohol. To forget despair. To survive even one day longer and resist the conclusion until the very end."

Poseidon remained silent for a long time. Bit by bit, as if refusing to admit it, he bit his lip several times before barely opening his mouth.

[Why did you come here?]

"You already know why I came."

Poseidon looked at me as if I were a strange creature.

[It seems my mind has gone weird now that it's time to die.]

"You were never quite normal to begin with."

A Myth-grade constellation who used to barge into scenarios at every opportunity to cause chaos. A strange feeling washed over me once again. Right now, I had become allies with a star that had been an enemy for the longest time.

Noticing my gaze, Poseidon spoke:

[I'm sorry, but current me won't be of much help. I am no longer the 'Spear Drawing the Boundary of Seas' you knew.]

Pressing his temple firmly with one hand, he continued:

[My status has fallen, and since a few weeks ago, a strange recorder sound keeps ringing in my head.]

A recorder sound.

"Looking at it, it seems you're not the only one."

Smiling faintly, I stood up from my seat and stared into a corner of the command tent. Crouched in that corner was the constellation who had entered the tent alongside Poseidon.

Poseidon said:

[That damn old geezer has been in that state continuously lately.]

A star taking the incarnation body of a frail old man was curled up in the corner, carving something. Scattered around him were various carvings. Divine relics of constellations. I recognized who each of those relics symbolized.

The one who lost an arm to the Wolf of Destruction, Tyr.

The guardian of the Bifröst Great Horned Bridge, Heimdall.

He was currently carving the dead constellations of <Asgard>.

"Odin."

Now, calling his true name right before him produced no sparks. Whether it was because this was the final phase of the scenario or because his status had fallen, I couldn't tell.

"You haven't forgotten, right? This scenario is the 'Great Destruction Scenario' of your <Asgard>. And the real 'destruction' hasn't arrived yet."

Odin continued carving without any reply. I spoke once more:

"You know, don't you? What the 'true conclusion' of Ragnarok looks like."

At my words, Poseidon and the four Kings held their breath.

「The true conclusion of Ragnarok.」

In truth, this 'Ragnarok' hadn't properly built up to its true 'conclusion' yet. And as long as Odin remained alive, we still had a chance to write that conclusion.

"Odin."

Releasing the status of my entire body, I spoke to him:

"If you still have one eye left, count clearly the number of stars remaining in this sky."

Only then did Odin slowly raise his head to look at me. Staring into his eyes, which reflected the ruined <Asgard>, I said:

"In 'Ragnarok', there are core battles that construct its epic."

[.....]

"The real Ragnarok isn't a flag-capturing war like this. It doesn't matter how many fortresses we lose. As long as we win the key battles, we can change the conclusion of 'Ragnarok'."

The core narrative of the Giant Story 'Ragnarok' wasn't merely a war between disasters and constellations. The primary narrative of 'Ragnarok' was slaying the disasters born to destroy the world—especially the core 'Great Disasters'.

Coincidentally, the first Great Disaster of 'Ragnarok' had already been awakened directly by Odin and <Asgard>.

「The King of Hell.」

Currently, that role was being performed by 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'. <Asgard> had fielded Heimdall as its adversary to face him, but unfortunately, they ended up losing the battle.

"Although the first battle was a defeat, other disasters remain. We just need to awaken all the other disasters and fight them."

The foundation of this 'scenario' was the Giant Story of 'Ragnarok'. As long as a 'stage' capable of overturning the scenario was created, reversing the tide of battle was possible at any time.

[Hold on, are you in your right mind?]

However, at my claim, the other 'Kings' seemed somewhat flustered. Meihouwang in particular wore an expression as if he had heard something absurd.

[We ended up like this because we couldn't handle the 'Master of the Erased Blank Space' alone, and you want to awaken the remaining disasters too?]

At that moment, Odin, who had remained silent all along, opened his mouth.

[Not long ago, an incarnation who came to see me said the exact same thing as you.]

With those words, Odin placed a newly made carving onto the ground. I looked down at the carving. It wasn't Thor's relic, nor was it Tyr's or Heimdall's. It was the weapon of a man I knew very well.

[That fellow also babbled nonsense that if we awaken and defeat all the remaining disasters, we might be able to win.]

Naturally, there was only one person in this world capable of spouting such nonsense. I picked up Odin's carving in my hand.

「Dark Heavenly Moon Spear.」

Forged like a pitch-black moon, the exclusive weapon of the 41st regression Yoo Joonghyuk.

At that moment, a chilling sensation brushed through my mind.

「Odin only carves the weapons of 'the dead'.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1051 Episode 65. The Last Banquet (2)

I paused for a moment. As if denying the record floating before my eyes, I slowly inhaled and declared:

"Yoo Joonghyuk doesn't die. Even if he's a guy who dies a lot, he's never someone who dies easily."

As proof of my words, the state of the 'Dark Heavenly Moon Spear' carving in my hand was quite different from the other carvings.

「The 'Dark Heavenly Moon Spear' carved by Odin has not broken yet.」

The divine relic carvings of the other constellations were all broken or heavily damaged. In contrast, the 'Dark Heavenly Moon Spear' showed no flaws or cracks. In other words,

Yoo Joonghyuk was not dead yet. Wherever he was and whatever he was doing right now, that guy hadn't died yet.

Yet Odin's expression wasn't bright.

[He dies.]

A voice closer to a calm statement of fact. Suppressing my inner turmoil deeply, I glared into his eye.

"Did you carve this beforehand because he looked like a guy about to die soon? So you could break it when he dies?"

[.....]

"I'm sorry, but that guy doesn't die. This carving will never break. So—"

Saying that, I tucked the carving into my breast pocket.

"I'll keep this as a souvenir."

It was to prevent Odin from accidentally snapping it. But as if all my efforts were meaningless, Odin slowly shook his head and said:

[He dies.]

Staring into his calm eye, I asked back:

"Did you see it with your one eye?"

Odin was a constellation who sacrificed one of his eyes to Mímir's Well to gain the truth of the world and foresight into the future. I knew all too well that his single eye reached into [Foresight], much like the 'Lump-bearing King' or 'Anna Croft'.

[I saw it.]

Even without using [Lie Detection], I could tell. Those words were true.

"When and how does Yoo Joonghyuk die?"

[That I do not know. But he will surely die. That is all I know.]

"Yoo Joonghyuk is a Regressor. As the incarnation of the 'Oldest Dream', there's no way he would die. Even if he dies, it's not a real death. What dies will be this world."

Odin also knew that the 'puppet of the Oldest Dream' repeated his life. So he couldn't deny my words. He shouldn't have been able to.

[He will finally gain peace through death.]

For a moment, I was rendered speechless. The 41st regression was the final turn Yoo Joonghyuk could reach before the proper 'Ways of Survival' began. His experiences and wisdom gathered up to this point would be passed to the 2nd regression, forming the foundation for the start of 'Ways of Survival' and the eventual birth of the 'Secretive Plotter'.

What became of the 41st regression's Yoo Joonghyuk afterward was never revealed.

「The Yoo Joonghyuk of this regression line will regress no more.」

I knew this too. It was information I had known from the very beginning. For a certain reason in this regression line, Yoo Joonghyuk meets a death without regression.

"Yeah, I suppose so. Humans all die eventually."

I had stayed too long in a scenario world where constellations, transcendents, and systems ran rampant, forgetting for a moment. It's normal for humans to die. What mattered was the manner of death.

"Maybe Yoo Joonghyuk will die too. But at least he won't die here. Because I'm going to make it so."

Wondering if I had ever had so many words inside me, I kept muttering continuously:

"That bastard will see the conclusion he wants."

Were these my words, or Kim Dokja's words? I couldn't tell. Perhaps they were Han Sooyoung's words. Or maybe another Kim Dokja fragment's words. They could have been Cha Seongwoo's, Lee Dansoo's, or Gyeong Sein's words. Or perhaps the words of an unnamed recorder reading this story right now.

"He will finally learn what happiness is, and what the reason for his existence was. He will surely be compensated for this long tragedy, for the life he has endured."

Whose words were they anyway? No matter whose words they were, in the end, this was my true heart.

"And he will die as a human."

[As a human?]

"Yeah, as a human."

After saying that, I paused. For some reason, my stomach felt turned. It felt as though the clumsily mixed Kim Dokjas inside me were shouting all at once.

「I wish Yoo Joonghyuk wouldn't die.」

I barely managed to stop those words from bursting out of my mouth.

「I wish he would remain the protagonist of this story forever. I wish this story would never end.」

One side of my heart constricted insanely.

[The Fable, 'Successor of the Eternal Name', chuckles and looks at you.]

[The influence of the Fable, 'Successor of the Eternal Name', grows stronger!]

Clutching my chest lightly, I took several deep breaths, forcing down the thoughts surging within me. Then I looked at Odin.

"Anyway, I need your help."

Setting down his carving knife, Odin slowly shook his head.

[I can do nothing.]

Knowing full well he would spout weak nonsense right off the bat, I didn't panic and picked up his words:

"Why? Because you lost to the Master of the Erased Blank Space?"

[The stars capable of ending 'Ragnarok' are all dead. Even one of them...]

Odin looked at me with a somewhat resentful gaze, concluding with a deep sigh:

[Did he not die at your hands?]

I quickly realized what Odin was talking about.

「The stars capable of ending Ragnarok.」

In the giant nebula <Asgard>, there were several stars representing the major events of 'Ragnarok'.

Thor, Thunder of Thursday.

Tyr, the One Who Lost an Arm to the Wolf of Destruction.

Heimdall, Guardian of the Great Horned Bridge.

Vidar, Terminator of War.

They were each fated to face their matching 'Great Disaster'.

「'Thor' who fights against the 'World Serpent' encircling the universe.」

「'Tyr' who fights against the netherworld gatekeeper 'Garm'.」

「'Heimdall' who fights against the King of Hell 'Loki'.」

「'Vidar' who fights against 'Fenrir', the Wolf That Swallowed a God.」

However, those four stars were not in this scenario right now. Heimdall died at the hands of Snowfield Kim Dokja right at the start of the scenario, while Thor and Tyr seemed to have met their end on the battlefield. Lastly, in Vidar's case—

"Ah."

Right. That bastard got killed by me back in 'New Martial Arts Earth'.

[It seems you finally remember.]

Technically, it was Yoo Joonghyuk who killed him, not me. Still, since he was a Fable-grade constellation, I thought he would have barely clung to life... Did he really die? Well, having his Fable entirely absorbed by Apollo, there was no way he could have survived.

I offered a faint smile toward Odin, who was glaring at me in disbelief.

"Well, there are plenty of actors who can perform the story, aren't there?"

[What—]

"Because stars are merely 'Fable-machines' existing solely to inherit stories. Right?"

At my words, Odin's shoulders twitched violently. Because what I had just said was also the long-cherished belief of Odin, the 'One-Eyed Father'.

「Every star is merely a small word to record a great Fable.」

In fact, adhering to that belief, Odin had resurrected dead constellations time and time again. Heimdall was such a case. Continuously passing down <Asgard>'s Fables, Odin had maintained his nebula by repeatedly reviving constellations destined to be sacrificed in the Great Destruction.

"You can just revive them again. Like you've always done."

[That is no longer possible. Because even the netherworld has vanished.]

"Who said anything about reviving them?"

[.....?]

"The stage doesn't remember who the 'actors' are. It merely remembers the 'roles'."

Realizing the meaning behind my words late, Odin's single eye widened.

[Don't tell me you...]

"That's right."

Reaching out my open palm toward Odin, I said:

"I'll be the one to revive the 'roles'. You just hand over the core Fable of 'Ragnarok' you possess."

Odin couldn't say a word, staring foolishly at my empty palm. I only regretted that the sky was pitch-black right now. If the stars could hear my proposal right now, they would have showered me with sponsorships.

[The constellation, 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', is amazed by your absurd proposal.]

Ah, right, these guys were watching.

[The constellation, 'Mass-Production Maker', nods saying it is just like you.]

[The constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire', feels a deep longing from your appearance.]

Meihouwang was staring at me with his mouth wide open, having forgotten to even use indirect messages. In truth, it was a situation worthy of that. Because my proposal right now—

[Are you... telling me to hand over all of <Asgard> right now?]

Odin's lips trembled violently at my sheer brazenness. I shrugged my shoulders at Odin and asked back:

"The nebula is ruined anyway, so what's there that you can't give up?"

[.....]

"If you leave it like this, you're finished anyway. So hand it over."

[Receiving the Fable... do you plan to create 'roles'?]

"Yeah."

[You should know the price of 'roles'.]

"I'll take care of that myself, so just hand over the Fable."

Odin was silent for a while, lost in thought. He parted his lips several times before looking at me with eyes cast in deep darkness.

[Do you know your own future?]

I wondered why he was suddenly talking about the future, but looking closely, his single eye was shining brightly.

"Can you see my future?"

Odin slowly shook his head.

[I cannot see it. But I can feel it.]

"Really? How is it? Do I die too?"

I let out a self-deprecating laugh after saying that. Odin stared into me for a moment before answering:

[Death is rather an easy salvation. In contrast, your future is...]

Beyond his single eye, a pitch-black darkness surged for a moment.

[So distant that even death cannot be seen.]

In the past, hearing those words would have plunged me into serious reflection. But not now. I didn't have the time for that.

"So, are you giving it to me or not?"

Looking at me with a somewhat dazed face, Odin answered hesitantly:

[Give me thirty minutes.]

With those final words, Odin curled back up in the corner. Staring down at Odin for a moment, I stepped out of the tent. Since he needed time, it seemed better for me not to be there.

Either way, Odin was in a situation where he had to hand over his Fable by betting his entire nebula. It wouldn't be an easy decision for him either. Well, if he didn't give it to me, I planned to take it by force anyway.

[You careless fool! Are you really planning to give that guy time?]

Turning around, I saw Meihouwang poking his head out from the tent.

"Yes."

[What if he suddenly runs away?]

"You'll just catch him and bring him right back, so what's there to worry about?"

At my words, Meihouwang's eyes flickered lightly. Twitching his lips with a dissatisfied expression, he added:

[I'll keep watch.]

"Thank you."

However, just as he was about to enter the tent, Meihouwang paused and asked:

[By the way, you fool, do you actually know what kind of Fable 'Ragnarok' is?]

"Of course."

[Then...]

Meihouwang scrutinized my face for a moment as if gauging my intentions, then let out a sigh.

[Never mind. Forget it. Come in quickly.]

With those words, Meihouwang disappeared back into the tent. Staring at the space where he disappeared for a moment, I raised my head and looked at the sky. Whether viewed from inside or outside the tent, the sky was still pitch-black. Far away, a star that looked like Uriel twinkled a faint light toward me.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja will descend here tomorrow.」

Now, the unavoidable final fight will truly begin. Yet strangely, I felt neither nervous nor scared. Perhaps it was because I, too, had endured a time that was far from easy.

[The Fable, 'Successor of the Eternal Name', nods.]

Still, that didn't mean I could greet him without any preparation. So, to prepare for the final stage, the first person I had to find was—

['Midday Tryst' has received a new message.]

The protagonist of this story, whose whereabouts were currently unknown.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1052 Episode 65. The Last Banquet (3)

I immediately activated 'Midday Tryst'. As expected, a message from Yoo Joonghyuk had arrived.

- ■■■ ■■ entrust ■■·····.

What was this? This message was also in a filtered state. To be precise, rather than filtered, the record was corrupted.

[The probability density of the current area is too high!]

[Currently, the use of 'Midday Tryst' in this area is not smooth.]

It wasn't even outside the scenario, but inside a main scenario area, yet this was the first time 'Midday Tryst' hadn't functioned smoothly. The record was so scrambled that it was

hard to tell properly, but it roughly seemed to say to leave this to him and get out.

I immediately sent a message using 'Midday Tryst'.

- Are you alive?

Seeing the message transmit, he definitely seemed to be within the same scenario area.

「"Yoo Joonghyuk went to rescue the other companions. There are people held captive in the Disaster Camp's fortress."」

Cha Yerin had left those words for me as she went to treat her injuries after coming out of the ossuary.

「"I told you just in case you were curious."」

Not just any Yoo Joonghyuk, but the 41st regression Yoo Joonghyuk charging into the heart of enemy territory to rescue companions. Before coming into this regression line, I wouldn't have believed it. But right now, my thoughts were different. The 41st regression Yoo Joonghyuk wasn't a monster who had lost his humanity as I once knew. At least, that was true based on what I had confirmed so far.

"Dokja-ssi."

Turning around, Jung Heewon was poking her head out from the tent.

"Why did you come out when you should be resting?"

"Because it's no fun inside."

Indeed, inside were only constellations right now. The other Kings didn't seem like they would match well with Jung Heewon's personality either.

Jung Heewon shook a bottle of alcohol and asked:

"Want another drink?"

"Sounds great."

The alcohol was what Poseidon had provided. Looking at it, it seemed to be a type of sacred liquor like 'Soma' or 'Amrita'. Jung Heewon took a few gulps straight from the bottle first before handing it to me. Feeling somewhat like I had returned to my early twenties, I grabbed the liquor bottle and drank.

"It's delicious."

"Right?"

Was it just my imagination? Sharing the drink, Jung Heewon looked to be in a slightly better mood. Come to think of it, I had never spent a time like this with Jung Heewon.

Thus, we took turns sipping the alcohol one gulp at a time. Watching the drink diminish, the thought suddenly crossed my mind that this moment was precious. Stories flow, and every moment passes. Ultimately, the world moves toward its conclusion. Had I read all these moments sufficiently before the conclusion arrived?

"Shall we run away?"

As if reading my state of mind, Jung Heewon asked in a voice touched slightly by intoxication.

"Just leave the scenario behind like this, and go far, far away together."

"The scenario would cause everything to end in destruction before long anyway."

"Would destruction really come so easily? And who knows? If we hide well, maybe we can survive. At least we might be able to live out the remaining lifespan we have left. Humans don't live that long originally anyway."

I let out a dry laugh. Both she who spoke and I who listened knew. We couldn't run away. Because both she and I were people who couldn't do such a thing.

"Heewon-ssi, is there something you want to do?"

"Something I want to do."

Only upon reaching the final scenario, on the tiny handful of blank space we had barely reached, were we asking each other about what we 'wanted to do'.

"What I want to do is something that can't come true."

"How do you know without trying?"

"Should I just try it?"

Staring at me blankly, Jung Heewon giggled softly and added:

"What I wish for is something impossible now."

Curious about what it was, I asked several more times, but in the end, Jung Heewon wouldn't tell me what she wanted to do. I spoke in a slightly exaggerated tone:

"That's cold."

"Who's the one really being cold to people here?"

"When was I ever cold?"

"You're not really asking because you don't know, are you?"

Looking slightly angry, Jung Heewon held the liquor bottle and tipped all the remaining drink down her throat.

"Heewon-ssi."

"What."

In truth, I knew. What she was upset with me about. But I am that kind of person. And Kim Dokja was that kind of human.

"We will win in the end, and the scenario will be resolved well. I can do it well. Don't worry too much."

At my words, Jung Heewon glared at me with narrowed eyes and said:

"Aren't you thinking that you have to do it, rather than that you can do it?"

"Yes. I have to."

Tapping the empty liquor bottle as if dissatisfied with my answer, Jung Heewon said:

"You're going to use an absurd method again, aren't you?"

"There might be times when I have to."

"Even if I tell you not to, you'll put your life on the line again."

I hesitated for a moment before nodding. Because I felt I had to be honest with her.

Jung Heewon bit her lip tightly.

"Can't we really just run away? What meaning is there in protecting this world to that extent? What even is this world?"

"I am responsible for this story."

I didn't think she would be able to understand this answer. However, everyone has a job they must accomplish, and for me, that was the conclusion of this story.

[The influence of the Fable, 'Successor of the Eternal Name', grows stronger.]

That was also the reason why I was currently being called Kim Dokja.

Jung Heewon stared at me for a long while before asking:

"If you save all these worlds by going that far, who is going to save you?"

"Pardon?"

"You... who on earth is going to save you?"

For a moment, I was rendered speechless. To be precise, I didn't know what answer to give. Was it because it was a question I had never thought about even once? Jung Heewon was looking at me quietly. Why was that? At that moment, it felt as if Jung Heewon was looking into a story inside me that I couldn't even look into myself.

[This crazy old geezer—]

At that moment, a small commotion echoed from inside the command tent. We immediately exchanged glances and pushed past the tent flap.

Entering the inner area of the command tent, we saw Meihouwang pinning Odin down with both hands.

"What's happening?"

[This old geezer suddenly started burning his own Fable!]

Burning his Fable? I rushed over to Odin. As Meihouwang backed off, I confirmed the Fable fragments scattering from Odin's grip.

[The Fable fragment, 'Fur of the Wolf That Swallowed a God', is destroyed.]

[The Fable fragment, 'Claws of the Netherworld Gatekeeper', is destroyed.]

It was true. The Fable fragments Odin possessed were scattering away. Moreover, they were all related to the 'Great Disasters'.

「To summon a Great Disaster, Fables related to them are required.」

Just like when <Asgard> and the constellations used their authority to designate 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' as the 'King of Hell', granting a role to a specific entity required the corresponding 'Fable fragments'. Odin's purpose in destroying the Fable fragments was clear. He was refusing to summon a new 'Great Disaster'.

[No, I told you! If you give this old geezer time, he'll definitely pull off something reckless!]

"Didn't you say you were keeping watch?"

[How was I supposed to know he would suddenly burn his own Fable? Smoke was coming out, so I thought he was just smoking a cigarette!]

Odin laughed like a madman looking at us.

[The Great Disasters must not be summoned. If even those are called forth, this world will surely be destroyed.]

Having been beaten up by Meihouwang, Odin had bruises scattered across his face. Grabbing the chin of the old Odin who was avoiding my gaze, I asked:

"You saw something, didn't you? With that 'single eye'."

[.....]

"What did you see? Tell me."

Odin kept his mouth firmly shut and didn't answer. For a certain reason, he had judged that I shouldn't awaken the 'Great Disasters'. Perhaps through his single eye, he had glimpsed something even more terrible than the Great Destruction.

However, I didn't panic. Because I had already anticipated that Odin might act like this.

It was then that a message floated into the air.

[The aura of a 'Great Disaster' has been sensed somewhere!]

[A new 'Great Disaster' will soon awaken!]

Panicking, Odin looked around the empty air and muttering:

[This—this makes no sense—]

What had happened was clear. Someone other than Odin had just awakened a 'Great Disaster' in this scenario.

"It seems even your single eye can't see everything."

With his single eye wide open, Odin glared at me and muttered:

[This cannot be. A 'Great Disaster' can only be called by one possessing the Giant Story of 'Ragnarok'...]

It was just as Odin said. However, there were hardly any stars left in <Asgard> right now, and Odin, having just burned his Fable, could no longer designate a 'Great Disaster' either.

"No, there is one more. An entity capable of doing that."

Realizing who I was talking about, Odin's shoulders twitched violently.

[If he has committed such an act, we have zero chance of victory.]

"You were even calculating our chances of victory amidst all this?"

Offering a faint smile, I looked up at the night sky. The surviving stars could be seen moving busily beyond the heavens. The Mass-Production Maker spoke:

[If it isn't a Great Disaster awakened by Odin, then it must indeed be that fellow's doing.]

I nodded. Excluding Odin, an absolute entity possessing the Fable of 'Ragnarok'. Surely he too was looking down at us from somewhere in this sky.

"It's actually better this way. Since we have to defeat another 'Great Disaster' anyway to create a stage advantageous to our side."

[Hmm, it doesn't look quite that positive to me, but if you say so, then so be it.]

"Can you tell us the location where the new 'Great Disaster' appeared?"

[The full scan of the 'Main Battlefield' region isn't quite finished yet.]

[If it's that, I can tell you.]

Unexpectedly, Poseidon, who had kept silent all along, stepped forward to help us. Appearing to still be in communication with Hermes's terminal, he closed his eyes briefly before opening his mouth:

[It seems to have appeared at the fortress in the east of the battlefield, a place called the 'Altar of Storms'. It's quite a distance from here.]

Altar of Storms. I repeated the name of the fortress in my mind. To increase even a sliver of victory for our side, we had to defeat the newly appeared Great Disaster before facing 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

[A new 'Great Disaster' begins to descend upon the battlefield!]

[A new 'Hidden Scenario' has started!]

A hidden scenario. It triggered as expected.

[The content of the 'Main Scenario' will soon be updated!]

Having checked the system messages, someone pushed past the command tent flap and entered just in time.

"What on earth happened?"

It was Cha Yerin. Having rushed over while receiving treatment, bandages were wrapped around various parts of her body. Calming her down, I conveyed the situation.

"A Great Disaster has been resurrected."

"Pardon?"

Despite the shocking news, Cha Yerin didn't seem greatly shaken. Perhaps she was too exhausted to be flustered any longer.

"Where is it? Did you find out the location?"

"It's a place called the Altar of Storms."

Hearing my words, Cha Yerin's eyes trembled violently.

"We have to go there right now."

I realized what Cha Yerin was about to say.

"Is that the place Yoo Joonghyuk went to?"

Cha Yerin nodded. I let out a groan. Of all places, a new 'Great Disaster' had resurrected at the very fortress Yoo Joonghyuk had gone to. But fortunately, we had an immediate means of transportation.

"Mass-Production Maker. Can we warp to that fortress using the flagship?"

[That can only be used once the scan of that region is complete.]

"How long will it take?"

[It will require about thirty minutes.]

Thirty minutes. Could Yoo Joonghyuk hold out for thirty minutes against a Great Disaster? He had become surprisingly strong, but if the opponent was a 'Great Disaster', there was no certainty.

"Heewon-ssi."

"Yes."

"May I ask you for one favor?"

"You want me to hit you hard enough to knock you out, right?"

Looking at her clenching her fist so naturally, I asked:

"...Have I asked you for such a favor before?"

Looking flustered, Jung Heewon tilted her head and said:

"I don't remember well, but I felt like I had to... Aren't you trying to use an ability that can only be used when unconscious?"

"That's correct, but..."

Come to think of it, Jung Heewon had made contact with the 1,864th regression Jung Heewon in the Third's worldline. Perhaps the memories of both existences had become tangled back then.

"I'll handle knocking myself out. What I need you to do is—"

The ability I was going to use this time wasn't [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]. Because that required Yoo Joonghyuk to be thinking of this side for it to trigger.

"If anything happens, hit me hard enough not to kill me to wake me up."

[You are currently in a state where you can use the authority of the 'Recorder of Fear'.]

[Manifesting the authority of the 'Recorder of Fear'!]

Looking at Jung Heewon who nodded with a tightly clenched fist, I closed my eyes with a somewhat anxious heart.

[Entering the 'Archives of Records' of the corresponding region.]

The Archives of Records. Originally a place one could only enter at set times, but once status rose as high as mine, such restrictions vanished. If it was the 'Archives of Records' where all records could be checked in real time, I would be able to observe Yoo Joonghyuk's current state as well.

Within the blurring surroundings, the sentences flowing out of the 'Archives of Records' began to invade my mind.

「There are two conditions for a 'Great Disaster' to descend. One is the existence of Fable fragments related to the 'Great Disaster'. The second is a powerful entity capable of bearing the role of the 'Great Disaster'.」

Come to think of it, the reason 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' could take on the role of a 'Great Disaster' was because <Asgard> used their Fable fragments to designate him as the 'King of Hell'. A question suddenly arose. Currently, in the Disaster Camp, excluding Snowfield Kim Dokja, who else could take on the role of a 'Great Disaster'? Interstellar Devourers or Outer Gods? Or perhaps constellations who had entered under his command, or the actual owners of that role like Odin or Thor.

[The Great Disaster, 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', is awakening!]

Likely, the disaster descending this time was 'Fenrir', the Wolf That Swallowed a God. Since Fenrir was a star standing on the side of 'disaster' even in actual mythology, it wouldn't be strange if he descended as this Great Disaster.

Following that, the Fable sentences possessed by the descending Great Disaster surfaced. And the moment I confirmed the first sentence of that Fable, I felt as if I had fallen into a deep abyss.

「"By the way, Captain, when is your birthday?"」

That was not Fenrir's Fable. Someone else had taken on the role of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' in place of Fenrir.

「"Ah, found it. Here it is. August 3rd."」

I knew who the owner of this Fable was. It felt like the gears in my mind were grinding to a halt.

「That's right. He was born in summer.」

If by any chance the 'Great Disaster' descending in place of Fenrir over there was that entity—

「In a summer when a hellishly hot and terrible storm blew.」

Yoo Joonghyuk will die today.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1053 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (1)

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The first time Yoo Joonghyuk witnessed someone's death was when he was fifteen years old.

「"You can't do it? Even like this? Even like this?"」

Under relentless, indiscriminate kicks, blood streamed continuously from the foreigner's nose and mouth.

「"Right, if you can't do it, you croak. There are plenty of people to replace you anyway."」

The one who said that was President Park, who ran an illegal gaming workshop. Yoo Joonghyuk couldn't quite remember why President Park had beaten the man. What Yoo

Joonghyuk remembered was the scene after President Park left after kicking him for a long time.

「"...Joonghyuk."」

At the foreigner's call, Yoo Joonghyuk walked closer as if possessed. The man reached out and grabbed Yoo Joonghyuk's ankle.

Yoo Joonghyuk didn't know what the foreigner's name was. He only knew that he was someone working alongside him, scraping by on the game money earned in the illegal workshop. In the first place, there were many such people in President Park's workshop.

「"....."」

The foreigner kept muttering something. Since he knew basic Korean, if he had something to say to Yoo Joonghyuk, he would have used Korean. But the man only repeated words in his native language.

「"....."」

Yoo Joonghyuk listened silently to the man's words. Even though he couldn't understand what it meant, he listened. For an hour, for two hours, he listened. Until the man's breathing finally ceased and President Park's voice calling for Yoo Joonghyuk could be heard from inside the workshop. Young Yoo Joonghyuk remained there, listening to his words. In the end, he never learned what the man had said while clutching his ankle.

The man's corpse was carried away somewhere the next day. Looking at the empty seat where the man used to work, Yoo Joonghyuk recalled the words he had muttered.

Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly wondered if his words had been a prayer toward God.

「"God? Where on earth is there a God?"」

Hearing Yoo Joonghyuk's words, President Park laughed at him mockingly:

「"Luck and talent are everything in this world. Joonghyuk, as it happens, you have both."」

Just as President Park said, Yoo Joonghyuk was lucky. The unlucky part was that President Park was also lucky. Realizing Yoo Joonghyuk's talent, President Park leaped into the esports industry with the money earned through the workshop. Thus, President Park became Coach Park.

「"Joonghyuk, this is our ground now. Hyung trusts only you. You know, right?"」

Just as Coach Park said, Yoo Joonghyuk possessed talent. Strangely, he quickly saw the rules of every game he touched. Yoo Joonghyuk built up proficiency at an abnormally rapid pace, overwhelming other pro gamers. His talent soon converted into money.

Yoo Joonghyuk won matches and earned money. He became able to feed his younger sister. They acquired a small house to live in together. While cooking meals for Yu Mia when she threw food tantrums, Yoo Joonghyuk held an expectation that perhaps God really might exist in this world.

「And then, the scenario began.」

President Park was right. There was no God in this world. Instead, blinding stars taking the place of God were there.

Yoo Joonghyuk performed scenarios. His life soon flowed into regressions. 1st regression, 2nd, 5th, 10th. Yoo Joonghyuk adapted quickly, but this game wasn't a form where one could win simply by adapting.

It felt as though he had become the foreigner beaten up by President Park. Fighting against absurd levels of violence and unreasonableness, Yoo Joonghyuk finally reached beneath the night sky of the 41st regression.

"As expected, there really is no God."

Looking up at the sky of the <Star Stream>, darker than ever before, Yoo Joonghyuk slowly composed his breathing. As he stood up, nursing his body that felt on the verge of breaking, Anna Croft spoke up as if waiting:

"What do you mean by there being no God?"

Without answering, Yoo Joonghyuk recalled the battle that had transpired until recently. Inside the ruined fortress—the inner castle of the 'Altar of Storms', the corpses of Outer Gods lay stretched out. There were as many as two corpses of Interstellar Devourers.

[You have achieved an unbelievable feat!]

[The siege of the fortress, 'Altar of Storms', has ended!]

[The corresponding fortress is now subordinated to the 'Constellation Camp'!]

[You have become the 'Commander' of the corresponding fortress!]

[Some Recorders are filled with awe at your incomprehensible combat strength.]

Gazing at the messages floating before his eyes for a moment, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke:

"What happened to the mission? Was everyone rescued?"

"Ren-ssi is moving. She says it's almost in the final stage."

"What is the condition of the rescue targets?"

"They all seem lacking in vigor, but they are said to be in good condition."

The core targets of this rescue operation were four in total. Lee Jihye, Shin Yoosung, Lee Hyunsung, and Lee Seolhwa. They had become prisoners of the enemy during the previous siege battle, and Yoo Joonghyuk had currently infiltrated to rescue them.

"What do you mean by lacking in vigor? Were they starved?"

"I'm not sure. However, it's said they looked like people whose energy had been drained by something."

Drained of energy? Thinking for a moment, Yoo Joonghyuk replied:

"I've prepared Sacred Fruit at headquarters, so have them consume it as soon as they return."

"I'll instruct them as such. By the way... you've really grown strong, Supreme King."

Anna Croft muttered in an awestruck voice, looking down at the fallen corpses of the Outer Gods.

"Infiltrating the fortress alone and wiping out the core warlords was not enough, but to even defeat the commander, an 'Interstellar Devourer'..."

On top of that, having dealt with a total of two 'Interstellar Devourers', including another summoned as reinforcements. In a sense, it was equivalent to defeating two 'Myth-grade constellations' simultaneously.

"Now, no star in that sky will be able to look down on you."

"Presumably. Since there are hardly any stars left in the sky now."

At Yoo Joonghyuk's words, Anna Croft opened her eyes wide in surprise.

"Were you someone who knew how to make such jokes?"

"I merely stated a fact."

Frowning quietly, Yoo Joonghyuk wiped clean the 'Dark Heavenly Moon Spear' stained with the Outer Gods' Fables. Watching him, Anna Croft spoke:

"This time, we might truly be able to see the world's conclusion."

"Did you see something with [Foresight]?"

"It's just my opinion."

About to mutter 'nonsense', Yoo Joonghyuk snapped his head up and looked at Anna Croft. If anyone else had said that, it would have been nonsense. But the one who spoke just now was the 'Prophet'. An Incarnation who overtrusted her [Foresight] more than anyone and never rashly asserted any future.

"I have such a premonition."

Such a Prophet was speaking her own hope—without any [Foresight]. Yoo Joonghyuk looked at Anna Croft silently. Then Anna Croft looked back at Yoo Joonghyuk as well. Neither said a word, but at that moment, both knew they were recalling the exact same name.

It was then that an explosion echoed.

"What happened?"

The fortress commander was dead, and the Outer Gods who had lost their leader had completely fled the fortress. There had been no intelligence about reinforcements coming from the Disaster side. Being quite a distance from other fortresses, there was no reason for a battle producing explosions to occur.

"Prophet."

Anna Croft's eyes were already glowing red. Her 'Great Demon's Eyes' had activated [Foresight]. But something was wrong. Her expression paled rapidly in real time, and blood-red Fables began streaming from her mouth.

"Anna Croft."

Yoo Joonghyuk supported the staggering Anna Croft. Anna Croft spoke in a trembling voice:

"How could this..."

At that moment, Yoo Joonghyuk recalled a memory from a very long time ago.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

Once upon a time, the foreigner who had grabbed his ankle. Just like that man back then, the Prophet was clutching his wrist. Looking at Anna Croft's slowly moving lips, Yoo

Joonghyuk thought about the foreigner who had prayed to God.

Even now, having endured through 41 regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk believed that man's words that day had been a 'prayer to God'. But only now, looking at Anna Croft's expression, did Yoo Joonghyuk realize. The words that foreigner had spoken to him that day were not a prayer. What he really wanted to say to him was—

"Run away."

"What?"

"You must not fight that thing. No matter if it's you, you cannot stand against a thing like that."

Like a person helplessly thrown before an utterly irresistible violence, Anna Croft continued as if screaming:

"Not you, nor any 'star' in this universe can face..."

She vomited red Fable just like that and passed out. It was strange. Even if she was a mere Incarnation, Anna Croft was a powerful Incarnation. Even if she had seen a future where Myth-grade constellations descended in swarms, she shouldn't have suffered enough shock to pass out merely from using [Foresight].

[The 'Great Disaster' prepares to descend!]

Only after checking the system message floating before his eyes did Yoo Joonghyuk realize what was about to happen. Though he didn't know the reason, a Great Disaster was attempting to descend here right now. Perhaps Anna Croft had seen the true identity of the 'Great Disaster' descending here in advance.

Thinking for a moment, Yoo Joonghyuk composed his breathing, calmly evaluated his full strength, and reached a conclusion.

「I will dispose of the 'Great Disaster' right here and now.」

Though the Prophet's warning weighed on his mind, if a 'Great Disaster' was truly descending, this was an unprecedented opportunity. Because hunting the Great Disaster was mandatory for a normal clear of this scenario.

「Slaying at least three 'Great Disasters' will secure victory in the final battlefield.」

The condition to fully reproduce the stage of 'Ragnarok'. Moving Anna Croft to a safe place, Yoo Joonghyuk used [Way of the Wind] to float above the fortress. He then declared to every being inside the fortress:

[Anyone who can hear my voice, get the hell out of this fortress right now.]

As his booming lion's roar echoed, busy movements were felt nearby. The 'Nameless Ones' hiding to preserve their lives. And Asuka Ren, who had rescued their companions, was seen carrying the collapsed Anna Croft away with the operational team.

- Yoo Joonghyuk, as for reinforcements...

To Asuka Ren's telepathic message echoing in his mind, Yoo Joonghyuk replied with a shake of his head:

"Unnecessary. It's an obstruction."

And in the next moment, the center of the pitch-black night sky began to swirl. Something was crossing over from beyond the vortex.

[The Great Disaster, 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', begins descending!]

The Wolf That Swallowed a God. Yoo Joonghyuk knew the owner of that modifier.

"Fenrir."

One of the Great Disasters of 'Ragnarok'. Considering the scenario difficulty up to now, the status of the descending 'Fenrir' would likely exceed that of a Myth-grade constellation. Yet Yoo Joonghyuk did not back down. He thought that level was actually worth fighting.

'An opportunity to verify the results of my training.'

Ever since finishing his training in the time fault, Yoo Joonghyuk had not met a proper opponent. Though he had dealt with two Interstellar Devourers, that had not required his full power either.

It was then that fine hairs stood up on the back of his hand. Though he composed his breathing several times, strangely, the goosebumps that had risen refused to settle down again.

「Overwhelmed merely by the presence. And by an entity still 'beyond'.」

It was unbelievable. Only once before had his body felt this degree of intimidation. The man who had taught him stabbing. Only he possessed such a presence.

'It's not Fenrir.'

He could tell instinctively. Though descending under the guise of the Fable of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', what lay beyond that vortex was not Fenrir. His instincts were warning him. The entity descending right now was incomparably more dangerous than the likes of 'Fenrir'.

'Strike before full descent.'

Drawing the 'Dark Heavenly Moon Spear', Yoo Joonghyuk aimed at the sky. Immediately, the 5th stage of Transcendence activated.

Soul-Slaying Divine Spear (滅魂神槍). Absolute Technique (絕技). The technique that had once shattered Poseidon's waves. Soul-Slaying Meteor Halberd (滅魂流星戟). A bundle of qi resembling a meteor shower soared into the firmament from his spear point.

A terrifying spear strike feared even by Myth-grade constellations. No matter how powerful the entity descending, it was an attack bound to suffer damage right now.

As the meteor shower drawing a brilliant trajectory was finally sucked into the vortex—

「That's right. He was born in summer.」

A somewhat familiar Fable echoed.

「In a summer when a hellishly hot and terrible storm blew.」

Beyond that Fable, someone was standing.

Kugugugugu!

Along with a brilliant explosion, the surging bundles of qi were seen scattering away.
Yoo Joonghyuk looked up at the sky with eyes filled with disbelief.

「Standing there was a man wearing the exact same black coat as him.」

However, what surprised Yoo Joonghyuk was neither that the man wore the exact same coat as him, nor that he possessed the exact same face as him.

「Perhaps 'God' really did exist in the world once.」

The extreme reachable by being born as a single existence. Martial power having reached the absolute end, unable to advance even a single step further. The wolf that had swallowed up all the stars in that sky was standing right there.

「Until that man killed 'God'.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1054 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (2)

It felt as if his spine was creaking. He had met many threatening enemies so far, but this was the first time he felt this way. Was that why? Yoo Joonghyuk instinctively activated a skill.

[Exclusive skill, 'Sage's Eyes Lv.?' is activated!]

In the next moment, along with fierce sparks, a portion of the descending existence's information rose before his eyes. Perhaps because the information was not yet unfiltered, he could not see the entire content, but at least one thing was clearly visible.

**[Exclusive Attribute: Regressor <1,864th round>]**

Yoo Joonghyuk doubted his eyes. With blank eyes, as if such a number could not possibly exist in the world, Yoo Joonghyuk read the number.

1,864.

It felt as if his head was going crazy.

"...Which round did you say?"

Without even realizing that he had blurted out a foolish soliloquy like Kim Namwoon, Yoo Joonghyuk read and reread that number. Throughout his repeated regressions, Yoo Joonghyuk had wondered just how many regressions he would have to undergo to see the conclusion. However, he had never once imagined such a number.

「"Right, since it's a scenario that can't be cleared even after regressing over a thousand times."」

The words he had heard in passing revived in his mind all at once. The words exchanged casually by Kang Ilhun, Ye Hyunwoo, and Kyung Sein.

「"It's only the 41st round, but can we really go all the way to the end?"」

「"It is indeed a pity. If that Yoo Joonghyuk were here, the scenario would have been much easier."」

'That Yoo Joonghyuk.' As his pounding heart calmed down, a memory resurfaced. He already knew the existence before his eyes.

"I think I know who you are."

Since arriving at 'Ragnarok', Yoo Joonghyuk had heard rumors about certain Outer Gods. The story of the Outer Gods who called themselves <Kim Dokja's Company>.

「"They are Outer Gods who came from another worldline."」

Lee Seyeon had introduced them that way.

「"Among them is you. He—"」

A monster who single-handedly repelled the Myth-grade Constellations of the night sky, and drove that 'Snow White' to the brink of death.

「"An existence who has already seen the end of the scenario."」

Yoo Joonghyuk gripped his spear tighter and stared at the disaster before his eyes.

Rumbleeee.

Wind, rain, and storms raged in the sky. In the midst of the storm, the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' could be seen slowly opening its eyes.

The moment his eyes met its, Yoo Joonghyuk experienced an illusion as if complete darkness was swallowing him. The terrible tragedies that took place in the distant universe were churning blackly inside the disaster's eyes.

Could he win? No, was a 'fight' even possible with such a thing in the first place?

「"Did you ask for my teachings with only that level of resolve?"」

Even amidst the rising doubts, Yoo Joonghyuk did not back down. Instead, the absurd words left by his new teacher filled his ears.

「"Any enemy will die if you stab them a hundred times. If a hundred times doesn't work, a thousand times; if a thousand times doesn't work, ten thousand times. If you stab them, they will surely die."」

Yoo Joonghyuk repeated the stabbing hundreds of millions of times inside the time fault. Throughout the repeated stabs, countless realizations rose and faded in his mind. He had experienced leaping to the transcendent state with overwhelming time density several times in previous rounds. However, this time, the level was different. In the terrifyingly consistent repetition, Yoo Joonghyuk spent more time in the 'time fault' than all his past rounds combined.

Thus, Yoo Joonghyuk caught a glimpse of a state he had never reached before. Although it was not enough to tear space-time apart with a stab like his teacher—

「At least enough to pierce this night sky.」

Soul-Slaying Divine Spear. Secret Technique. A formidable status began to swirl from Yoo Joonghyuk's spear. A dazzling golden spear force. The light rays wrapped around the tip of the spear were just like the starlight in that night sky.

Star Carving.

Yoo Joonghyuk's triceps, which he had pulled back with all his might, contracted, and a massive explosion occurred. With a feeling as if space-time was slowing down, Yoo Joonghyuk's figure vanished on the spot. If a chronicler had seen that scene, they would have described it as follows:

「A star twinkled in a very distant place.」

A body that had reached its limit. Becoming a single star with the explosive power of his quadriceps and gluteus maximus, Yoo Joonghyuk shot like a flash of light toward the great disaster in the sky.

「The moment of witnessing the starlight on the spear point would be the last sight his opponent would ever see.」

The technique Yoo Joonghyuk created by shaping his past realizations. Finally, at the moment when the starlight spearhead pierced the firmament and carved a star in the night sky—

Crack.

The spearhead was caught in a hand flowing with pitch-black status. The starlight scattered in the night sky like a faint light sucked into a black hole.

It was impossible. His teacher had said that there were no more than five people in the <Star Stream> capable of catching 'Star Carving'. Yet the guy before his eyes—

「Caught 'Star Carving' with just one hand.」

Yoo Joonghyuk felt the hand holding the spear tremble.

"Indeed, if it is the 'me' of the 1,864th round, it should at least be at that level."

As if responding to those words, the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' let out a roar. Subsequently, an unusual change occurred throughout his body.

「The story of the great disaster was wrapping around him.」

As the muscles of the great disaster swelled, the already large man's physique transformed into an even more imposing figure. His hair grew long, and his coat changed into the shape of a fur coat. Covered in long, flowing black hair, the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' slowly opened its mouth.

The great disaster that looked down on the world. The first word he uttered was— someone's name.

Frowning, Yoo Joonghyuk tried with all his might to pull the spearhead caught in the guy's right hand. But the spear would not budge. An absurd grip strength. Rather, the more he tried to pull the spear, the stronger the force holding his spear became.

"Why are you looking for that guy?"

Yoo Joonghyuk knew the owner of that name. There were several owners of that name, but to Yoo Joonghyuk, there was only one existence that name pointed to.

「For just a brief moment, a face with narrow eyes flashed through Yoo Joonghyuk's mind.」

An unknown sense of threat. In that instant, Yoo Joonghyuk felt like he knew who the 'disaster' before him was looking for. Perhaps because of that, Yoo Joonghyuk muttered words he wouldn't normally say.

"The guy you are looking for is not in this world."

In the next moment, Yoo Joonghyuk felt his field of vision spin. A terrible nausea, followed by a pain in his jaw. When he came to his senses, he was stuck upside down in the ground.

「He didn't see the strike at all.」

He barely raised his status to pull himself out of the ground, but the disaster was not visible in the night sky. With a chilling sensation on the back of his neck, Yoo Joonghyuk reflexively ducked.

Kwaaaaa!

A crushing sound, as if space itself was breaking, echoed from the fist the guy swung. Did his words provoke the disaster? The disaster's two eyes, briefly visible, were half-rolled back.

[The energy of the great disaster, 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', becomes even stronger!]

The guy's fist struck once again at a speed invisible to the eye.

"Keo-heok."

With the sensation of a hole being pierced in his stomach, Yoo Joonghyuk flew straight through the air. The disaster pursued Yoo Joonghyuk, who was flying at a phenomenal speed. The immense status imbued in the disaster's fist slammed down toward him once more.

「He will die.」

He thought he had strengthened his body to the limit. But a monster far worse was right in front of him. Now that it had come to this, he also had to exert his full strength.

「"You, you've engraved a special imprint on your body."」

Yoo Joonghyuk recalled his teacher's words.

「"If you rely on such expedients, you will end up dead."」

He knew. But there was no other way right now. If he couldn't overwhelm the guy even with a body that had reached its limit—"You are not the only one who can transform into such a form." He had no choice but to face him, even if it meant releasing the limit.

「Restraint of Truth」

'Restraint of Truth.' A 'story imprint' that manifests power at the cost of sealing a portion of memories from past rounds.

「"Joonghyuk-ssi, don't forget. Even if you are left alone in this world, never forget that you did your best, and that there were surely people who cheered you on."」

As the first story imprint was released at the cost of memories, a fierce vitality surged from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

「Restraint of Emotions」

'Restraint of Emotions.' An imprint paid for at the cost of one's emotions. A 'story imprint' where the more it is used, the more reason is lost, and one's identity as a human

is gradually eroded.

['Beastification' is activated!]

Tzztzztzz.

The muscles of his entire body expanded, swelling like those of a beast. The body that he thought had reached his limit was evolving once again. Soon, his appearance became similar to the 'great disaster' before him.

Perhaps having felt interested in Yoo Joonghyuk's transformation, the gaze of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' changed for the first time.

「Two beasts, looking identical like twins, faced each other.」

A tension that froze even their breathing. In the moment a breath of white steam rose, Yoo Joonghyuk moved first. As Yoo Joonghyuk instantly narrowed the distance and swung his fist, the great disaster also swung a fist in response. Two fists containing the essence of [Breaking the Sky Force Punch] clashed in midair, generating a gale.

Rumbleeee!

Like two beasts fighting for territory, the two Yoo Joonghyuks fought, entangled with each other. They swung their forepaws at each other and growled as if to bite each other's throats.

In an instant, hundreds of exchanges of attack and defense followed. They struck each other's faces and beat each other's abdomens. Every single blow was a strike capable of instantly killing a Historical-grade Constellation. However, neither of them backed down.

Even while stories, instead of blood, bubbled up, Yoo Joonghyuk swung his fists again and again. The joy of being able to test his strength to the limit. The pleasure of clashing with someone with all his might.

「It is fun.」

Did that guy feel the same way right now? Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly looked into the disaster's eyes. However, what was reflected in the disaster's pupils was not his face. It was simply a gaze that searched for something beyond with empty pupils.

'Was I the only one fighting with everything I had?'

Yoo Joonghyuk somehow felt his pride hurt. Perhaps that was why he used that 'story'.

[Giant Story, 'Forest of Stars and Humans', begins its storytelling.]

A story obtained by defeating 'Apollo', who had reached the Myth-grade, in the 'New Murim District' together with Kim Dokja. Imbuing his fist with the blessing of that story, Yoo Joonghyuk punched the abdomen of the great disaster with all his might. Along with a roaring sound like a drum bursting, there was a clear feeling of a solid hit.

The great disaster, which staggered for a moment, caught the wrist of Yoo Joonghyuk who had struck his abdomen. And—

【Kim Dok ja】

The expression of the great disaster that verified the story changed strangely. Soon, a storm of stories began to rage from his entire body. At the point where the two people's statuses clashed, sparks of Probability burst out.

[A probability aftermath is rushing in!]

[The 'Disconnected Film Theory' is activated!]

Yoo Joonghyuk hurriedly tried to pull out his captured hand. However, the disaster did not let go of his hand. As if it had no intention of letting go of the story he showed.

「Stories and stories began to entangle.」

With an encroaching sense of crisis, Yoo Joonghyuk raised his status to protect himself. However, a tidal wave of stories stronger than that was rushing in before his eyes. It was the story possessed by the 'great disaster'.

[Great Disaster, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' begins its storytelling.]

"Keuk—"

Yoo Joonghyuk felt his breath get stuck in his throat. A truly massive story, unbelievable to be the history of a single person, was creating an immense story pressure.

「The 1,864th round that he had experienced was before his eyes.」

In the storm of stories, Yoo Joonghyuk clearly saw the story experienced by the great disaster before him.

「"It is an odd name."」

That story began by meeting one person,

「"Kim Dokja! No!"」

and led to the death of one person,

「"Kim Dokja!"」

and to reclaim that person, it has continued until now. At the end of the long journey solely to reclaim his companion, the being who eventually became a great disaster was right before his eyes.

Tzztzztzztzz!

Yoo Joonghyuk suddenly felt his presence weakening. The reason was clear.

[The 'Disconnected Film Theory' is activated!]

As if refusing to acknowledge that two Yoo Joonghyuks existed in this world, or like a larger star sucking in the starlight of a smaller star—the 'great disaster' before him was absorbing his story.

Belatedly, Anna Croft's words came to his mind.

「"They said they looked like people whose energy had been stolen by somewhere."」

In front of the distant history of the 1,864th round, the time of the 41st round he had lived was a mere instant. The larger history was eating the smaller history.

Yoo Joonghyuk muttered as if resisting it.

"I am—"

However, his muttering was quickly crushed in the storm of stories blowing before him.

「I am Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Only then could he see the disaster's face properly. And Yoo Joonghyuk realized.

「Yoo Joonghyuk was right before him.」

The real Yoo Joonghyuk was there. The Yoo Joonghyuk who had crossed a grand history spanning 1,864 rounds to come here. The Yoo Joonghyuk who descended upon this world to save someone, to fulfill all of his duties, was right there.

「In front of him, no Yoo Joonghyuk could dare to falsely call himself 'Yoo Joonghyuk'.」

Yoo Joonghyuk's soul was fading. As if his history was surrendering to the history lived by the existence before him, it was collapsing.

"I am..."

Yoo Joonghyuk blankly parted his lips. If he disappeared here, if he gave up everything and closed his eyes, wouldn't it be easier that way? If he returned to that existence and became 'one Yoo Joonghyuk'...

At that moment, like a buoy floating on a raging tidal wave, a single sentence surfaced.

「...is.」

Yoo Joonghyuk instinctively looked at that sentence.

「...You are Yoo Joonghyuk.」

The moment he read that sentence, Yoo Joonghyuk regained his senses along with the feeling of someone hitting the back of his head hard.

「No matter what anyone says, you are the only Yoo Joonghyuk of this worldline.」

There was a person who remembered him there. An existence who recognized his history of living only 41 rounds.

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Rewrites Eternity', is looking at you.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1055 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (3)

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Fortunately, Yoo Joonghyuk was not dead yet. I let out a sigh of relief as I checked Yoo Joonghyuk's appearance reflected on the screen of the 'Record Archive'.

Tzztzztzztzz!

Yoo Joonghyuk was looking up at the sky in the midst of the raging sparks. He probably saw the sentence I wrote.

"Why are you standing there blankly, Yoo Joonghyuk! Pull yourself together!"

The situation was clear.

「Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> descended as the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God'.」

The worst-case scenario I could imagine became reality. I thought, biting my lower lip.

「Why did Yoo Joonghyuk choose to become a 'disaster'?」

Yoo Joonghyuk was someone who knew the danger of a 'disaster' better than anyone. He, who had faced the Outer Gods of the 999th round and the 'Secretive Plotter' in the main story, and who knew better than anyone what a 'disaster' meant to another worldline, would never choose to become a 'disaster' of another worldline. Especially if it was the great disaster of 'Ragnarok' that finalized destruction.

「Is this also the plan of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'?」

No matter how much I thought, no other reason came to mind. However, I still couldn't understand. He was none other than the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>. Even if it was 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', would he have the power to turn that Yoo Joonghyuk into a 'disaster' without any persuasion?

Tzztzztzztzz!

Even to me beyond the screen, the pressure of the aftermath occurring there was palpable. Though I couldn't know for sure, Yoo Joonghyuk at the center of the storm must feel like his entire body is being disassembled by now.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Despite my call, Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer. I kept watching Yoo Joonghyuk and quickly scanned the before and after records causing the aftermath.

[Currently, the 'Disconnected Film Theory' is active!]

Since the two Yoo Joonghyuks clashed head-on, it was self-evident that the 'Disconnected Film Theory' would activate. The problem was the very form in which the 'Disconnected Film Theory' activated.

「Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round was being disassembled.」

When the story fusion of two existences—that is, 'film pasting'—occurs, the 'larger history' inevitably eats the 'smaller history'. Furthermore, even more so in a situation where they are clearly hostile to each other like now.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Whether he heard my shout, the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round raised his head again.

「You are Yoo Joonghyuk.」

Relying on the insignificant record I wrote, the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round stood there.

Yoo Joonghyuk, the Supreme King of the <Star Stream>. The man who looks down on the world, destroys stars, and proves himself solely by the life he has lived. It was the first time I saw that Yoo Joonghyuk make such an expression.

"Pull yourself together! Damn it!"

I didn't want to see such a face. A lack of confidence in Yoo Joonghyuk of all people. I didn't come all the way here to see such a sight.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Yoo Joonghyuk's figure swayed precariously. Amidst the raging history of the main story, the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round was poised to sink like a paper boat in a rough sea.

Clenching my fists tight, I opened my mouth.

"You, too."

I know, too. If the opponent is the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>—if the history we have to fight is that 『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint』, then naturally, our probability of winning is almost zero.

"You didn't just live for nothing either."

But even so, it didn't mean that the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round had endured a history that deserved to be ignored.

"Have you forgotten everything! What events happened in this round! What kind of time we went through to get here!"

Even if everyone else forgets, I know. What kind of person he is. What he lost, and what he protected to survive up to this point.

[Giant Story, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' continues its storytelling.]

The history of the main story crashed before Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes like a panorama. A story that could not be resisted alone. A part of that history flickered, evoking a familiar sentence like an illusion.

「"Why are you here?"」

The figures of Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Dokja, invited to the Constellations' Banquet, were there.

「"Probably for a similar reason as you."」

The Banquet of Constellations. Of all things, it was an episode I liked. Raising his hand in the screen, Kim Dokja said:

「"If you want to sell stories to me and Yoo Joonghyuk, trade with our 'Nebula'."」

The story I loved approached as if to swallow the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round. As the story came right before him, Yoo Joonghyuk unconsciously reached out his hand. Even though the back of his hand was cut to pieces, Yoo Joonghyuk did not take his eyes off the story. It was not simply because he was fascinated by the story.

Perhaps right now, Yoo Joonghyuk—

"Do you remember?"

He must be thinking of the same story as me.

"We were also invited to a banquet once. Though no one welcomed us."

Along with my words, stories rose from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

[Story, 'Recycling Center' begins its storytelling!]

The Recycling Center. There, we attended the 'Zodiac Ball' and went to a strange school together. In the end, the scenario ended up in a mess due to the Constellations' interference.

"I haven't forgotten that you came to save me when I was exiled from the scenario."

More than eight years have passed since then, but I still remember the Yoo Joonghyuk of that day. Carrying me, who was kicked out to the non-scenario region, and running through the void for three days straight to escape the pursuit of distant constellations. I remembered us on that day, running desperately and finally meeting the 'Monarch Slayer', clearer than anyone else.

Whether he heard my shout, I saw a bit of light return to Yoo Joonghyuk's pupils. But meanwhile, the story over there also changed.

「"I'm thinking of going to the 'First Murim'."」

The figures of Yoo Joonghyuk and Kim Dokja walking in Murim were there.

「"Your eyes are burning hot. Do you perhaps adore me?"」

The encounter with the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, Yoo Joonghyuk getting hit on his butt. Following that, the Great Destruction Scenario that visited Murim.

「[I am the god of this Murim, the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint.]」

Just by looking at it for a brief moment, it felt like being sucked into the story. This was the power of a completed story. The power of a story that stole the eyes of the stars and even absorbed the soul of the viewer.

"We also went to Murim."

Perhaps our story was not as glamorous as the main story.

"There, we also ate 'Murim Dumplings'. We even got dragged to the Namgung Clan while criticizing franchise dumplings. Is that all? We also met the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint."

The meeting with the 41st round's Breaking the Sky Sword Saint was not as pleasant as the main story.

「"You are an interesting child. Just who is the 'Breaking the Sky Sword Saint' you know?"」

Because immediately after meeting her, the Outer Gods' invasion began, and the 'Fear Realm' opened right after.

"Thinking about it, we almost died there, too."

We almost died there, too. Chased by Outer Gods, chased by the fears of the Fear Realm.

"But."

Surviving through all the ups and downs every time, we came all the way here.

"I had fun."

Experiencing those ups and downs together, we became each other's companions.

"To be able to live through this story together, I was really happy."

To Yoo Joonghyuk who had lived through dozens of rounds, this brief bond might be nothing. Perhaps there wasn't even an emotion worthy of being called a bond. Nevertheless—

"It is filled with nothing but memories of almost dying."

When I suddenly raised my head, Yoo Joonghyuk was looking at me. Light had returned to his previously blurry eyes.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

Fortunately, Yoo Joonghyuk's complexion seemed to be returning little by little. Although he was still at the center of the raging aftermath, unlike before, his status was enduring the aftermath. His story, firmer than before, began to protect his incarnation body.

"Have we entered the 'Main Battlefield'?"

"Yes. We are a bit late."

"It would have been useless even if you came early."

I understood what Yoo Joonghyuk meant. He meant that against such a 'great disaster', it would have been the same whether he was alone or together. However, Yoo Joonghyuk, who said those words, did not look particularly discouraged. If anything, his eyes looked strangely relieved.

"Why do you have an expression as if everything is over?"

Tzztzztzz, once again the aftermath raged inside the screen. Was it because of the influence of the 'Disconnected Film Theory'? The 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' was frowning, clutching his head where stories spilled out. A fierce story was raging at his base, making it impossible to approach, but it was clear that he was in pain.

Watching him, Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth.

"You must know. That the 'me' who lives the 1,864th round exists somewhere in this universe."

I inhaled sharply. Come to think of it, the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round was meeting the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> for the first time right now.

"I heard that the 'me' of that round saw the end of the scenario."

I hesitated for a moment, then nodded.

"That's right."

Hearing my words, Yoo Joonghyuk silently stared at the great disaster, the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>, the self of another world. Only then did I feel like I knew what Yoo Joonghyuk was thinking.

"Are you relieved?"

Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk was finally rejoicing at the future he had reached. Penetrating through those distant years—was he finally facing himself, who had ultimately reached the conclusion of all stories?

"I thought that it would surely exist somewhere in another universe."

I knew what emotion he would feel. On one hand, I wanted to share the deep emotion he was feeling.

"But that is not you."

But that is not you.

"It is you, but it is not the you of this place."

Perhaps I was afraid that Yoo Joonghyuk might think otherwise.

"We can also see the conclusion. I know that you lived harder than any other Yoo Joonghyuk."

I might have been afraid that he would give up the conclusion of this round just because the conclusion he wanted existed somewhere in a distant universe.

"I know."

"Of course. That's not me."

As if my concern was laughable, Yoo Joonghyuk, who found me accurately in the empty sky, wore a somewhat self-deprecating smile.

"Because if it were me, there is no way I would ever regress 1,864 times."

At those words, I also ended up chuckling.

"Indeed. If it were you—"

It was at that moment that I felt a sense of incongruity. It was a strange feeling. A sensation as if the back of my neck was creaking again. I felt like I was missing something.

I saw the aftermath of Probability slowly diminishing inside the screen. As the sparks faded, the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>, who had transformed into the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', became clearer.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

The moment I met his empty eyes, I realized what I had missed.

"How did you know that he is from the '1,864th round'?"

"I saw it with [Sage's Eyes]."

I expected as much. But.

"That shouldn't be possible."

That was impossible. Certainly, that 'Yoo Joonghyuk' was the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> that I knew, and the round he lived was the 3rd round as well as the 1,864th round. But that was only the story of the 'round' he lived. If that Yoo Joonghyuk was truly the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>, there was no way such information would appear in [Sage's Eyes]. It shouldn't have appeared. Because—

「"Now, I am no longer a regressor."」

Because he was no longer a 'regressor'.

「With the disappearance of the single reader, his story came to an end. And so did his final regression.」

At the conclusion of the main story, he finished his final regression and lost the [Regression] attribute he possessed.

"No, he is without a doubt the 'regressor' of the 1,864th round."

Yoo Joonghyuk was right. Because now, it was visible to my eyes as well.

**[Exclusive Attribute: Regressor <1,864th round>]**

My heart felt like it was freezing cold. There was no way that Yoo Joonghyuk would have become a 'regressor' again. If so, there was only one answer.

「Just what on earth did you do to Yoo Joonghyuk?」

Snowfield Kim Dokja.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1056 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (4)

Poseidon stared at the fierce battle unfolding before his eyes. The vision visible through the terminal left by the Master of Sky Walk—'Hermes'. Two wolves with scattering beast fur were stretching their fists toward each other.

Boom—!

Every time their fists crossed, it felt like the universe was undergoing an earthquake.

Rumbleeee!

A battle of attack and defense that made even Myth-grade Constellations hold their breath. Poseidon unconsciously gripped the trident stuck in the floor. His story was wavering. The heart of the ancient sea was beating with a tremor.

「In this world, such a story still remains.」

A landscape that only those who can risk all their stories solely to reach ■■ can paint. If it were in the past, he also would have jumped into that landscape. Engaging in a life-and-death struggle by risking all his stories, he would have entrusted his incarnation body to the blood-splattered festival of stories.

But now, he was old. The spear that draws the boundary of the sea. That was the modifier calling him today. Thus, all he could do now was childishly draw a line of his own and vent his anger at the enemies crossing that boundary.

As if deeply resentful of that fact, Poseidon picked up the cup containing soma and moistened his throat. Although he drank a holy fluid sweeter than any alcohol in the world, the aftertaste lingering in his mouth was bitter.

[Odin, it must be visible to your single eye as well.]

His only consolation was that he was not the only 'Myth-grade Constellation' watching that landscape. Not only he and Odin, but there were still Constellations of the Round Table surviving in this world. Stars hiding like parasites somewhere in this battlefield, waiting for the Great Destruction to arrive.

[Will you just keep watching like this?]

At Poseidon's question, Odin slowly raised his head. His single eye flashed with a sharper blue light than usual.

[What do you want from me, Spear that Draws the Boundary of the Sea.]

[This stage is your 'Giant Story'.]

Ragnarok. The world's Great Destruction. The final battlefield of <Asgard>.

[And right there now is the great disaster you must fight against.]

Even at Poseidon's words, which were strangely mocking, Odin made no reply. Perhaps displeased with such an attitude, Poseidon opened his mouth again.

[Surely you haven't forgotten your own story. The 'great disaster' that incarnation is fighting right now is originally the 'adversary' you should face.]

Indeed, even now, faint sparks were flying from Odin's incarnation body. Just by staring at the landscape, Odin was being drawn to that story.

Odin stared blankly at the landscape, then slowly blinked his eye and retorted.

[I thought you had no interest in what lies beyond the boundary you drew.]

[Didn't you want to remain as a great record? Isn't that why you taught your children the same worldview?]

Poseidon knew well what the heads of each 'Great Nebula' had been doing. The repeating and reproducing of 'Giant Stories' solely to maintain the power of Myth-grade Constellations. For that purpose, highest-tier gods like Odin resurrected Constellations to be used as scapegoats time and time again. And they let those stars die on the 'fake stage' they created.

「Only to make sure their stories are not forgotten in this universe.」

Odin glared at Poseidon for a moment, then spoke.

[In this world, my children are no longer here.]

[That must be so. Since your children are all dead.]

[Just what on earth do you want to say?]

[Are you afraid of death?]

Death. Watching Odin's expression stiffen, Poseidon continued to ask.

[Does the great 'All-Father' abandon the holy war before his eyes for only that reason?]

[.....]

[If this stage were 'Gigantomachia', I would have jumped in without hesitation.]

Putting down his cup before he knew it, Poseidon stood up from his seat, grasping his trident. Then, he spoke to Odin, who was still sitting down, as if shouting at him.

[If you are just going to keep watching like that, hand over your story to me. I would rather directly—]

It was then that a roaring sound was heard. The Monkey King, who was quietly sitting cross-legged and meditating; the Black Flame Dragon, who was closing his eyes as if bored; and the Mass Production Maker, who was listening to the argument between the two Myth-grade Constellations with interest, all looked at the same empty space at once. The same system message popped up before their eyes.

[A new great disaster is preparing to descend!]

The 'Mass Production Maker' opened his mouth.

[It seems another great disaster has appeared.]

When dawn comes, 'King of Hell' Snow White will visit this place. In addition, the great disaster 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' appeared just a moment ago. But was that not enough? This time, a 'third great disaster' had announced its appearance.

The Mass Production Maker looked back at their fallen commander. The blonde man embraced in Jung Heewon's arms had a grim expression, perhaps because he was fighting a hard battle.

[Someone must buy time until he returns.]

It was impossible to know what kind of existence the new great disaster was. Only one thing was certain.

「The star that leaves this place to face that great disaster will surely disappear from this sky.」

As if that fact was strangely exciting, the Mass Production Maker sneered and looked around at the stars in the situation room.

[Now, it's time to decide who among us will die first.]

*

"It's coming."

Along with Yoo Joonghyuk's warning, an explosion erupted before his eyes. In the midst of the raging story of the 1,864th round, the great disaster's fist flew in.

Boom!

Yoo Joonghyuk was pushed back with a massive impact. The story of the 1,864th round overflowed into the air as fragments. Looking at that story, I was certain.

「There was no mistake. Snowfield Kim Dokja did something to Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>.」

Yoo Joonghyuk said, releasing his arms that barely blocked the great disaster's fist.

"It seems the guy has come to his senses."

"No, he's still not in his right mind."

"How do you know that?"

"Would Yoo Joonghyuk in his right mind be muttering only 'Kim Dokja' like that?"

"....."

"It seems his story has been manipulated."

I calmly examined the great disaster's story once again. No matter how much it was Snowfield Kim Dokja, he could not turn the Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>, who had already lost his stigma, back into a 'regressor'. It was natural. Just because

Snowfield Kim Dokja could use the authority of the 'Oldest Dream' did not mean he had truly become the 'Oldest Dream'.

Probably, that Yoo Joonghyuk is currently in a state where he believes himself to be the 'regressor of the 1,864th round' due to the authority of Snowfield Kim Dokja.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk, who was a regressor."」

I didn't know why Snowfield Kim Dokja did such a thing, but for us right now, it was a rather troublesome situation.

Hearing my words, Yoo Joonghyuk nodded and said.

"I don't quite understand what you mean, but if he's out of his mind, it'll be easier to deal with him instead."

"Well, perhaps that 'Yoo Joonghyuk'—"

The Yoo Joonghyuk of the '1,864th round'. I clearly remembered when his attribute was first marked as the '1,864th round' in the main story.

「The decisive battle with the 'Secretive Plotter'.」

He had lived as the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 3rd round throughout the main story, only to awaken in the battle with the 'Secretive Plotter' and obtain the memories of the '1,864th

round'. Although in that battle, the 'Secretive Plotter' held back to some extent, and there was the effect of 'Stage Transformation'—he was the only Yoo Joonghyuk who had ever defeated the 'Secretive Plotter', who could be called the strongest in all this universe.

"He is probably almost the strongest Yoo Joonghyuk in the entire universe."

And right now, the ones opposing him are merely the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round and a half-baked Kim Dokja.

"If I defeat him, I will become the strongest now."

"Are you confident?"

"If I keep stabbing, we'll get through it somehow."

"That sounds like something Mr. Jaehwan would say."

"If a hundred stabs don't work, a thousand; if a thousand stabs don't work, ten thousand."

"Has even your brain become identical to Mr. Jaehwan's now?"

Of course, if it were the 'Monarch Slayer' Jaehwan, he might deal with the Yoo Joonghyuk before him in that manner. But that was only possible for a crazy Mr. Jaehwan.

"First, we must buy some time."

I looked at the great disaster pressing his temples in the midst of the aftermath. No matter what kind of Yoo Joonghyuk he was, his role on this stage right now was the 'great disaster'.

[The influence of the great disaster, 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', becomes even stronger!]

The important thing is to use the effect of this stage. And for the effect of the stage to be maximized, a prerequisite was needed.

「The condition will be met soon.」

Call it the intuition of a writer, or a reader. The event that will satisfy the condition will occur soon. Because that is the 'Ragnarok' I know. The important thing is for Yoo Joonghyuk and me to survive until that condition is satisfied.

"From now on, it's up to you."

I spoke while picking up and quickly processing records discarded throughout the battlefield, like scooping soil from the ground.

"Only one blow is needed. Can you land a clean hit on the disaster?"

The opponent was indeed the worst adversary we could ever meet. Nevertheless, Yoo Joonghyuk nodded calmly.

"It is possible."

Yoo Joonghyuk gripped his Dark Heavenly Moon Spear. A powerful story was condensing on his spearhead. Subsequently, the moment the great disaster noticed our existence and revealed his status toward this side—

"Then let's begin."

Yoo Joonghyuk ran. And my record accompanied his running steps. With every step he took, our story was loaded.

Suddenly, the moment I first met the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round came to mind.

「"Why are you here?"」

At that time, Yoo Joonghyuk had called me 'Cheon Inho'.

Rumbleeee!

As if instinctively sensing danger, stories streamed incessantly from the disaster's entire body. The 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword'. The weapon that accompanied him through

the scenarios of the 1,864th round roared violently in his grip. A technique known to both me and Yoo Joonghyuk was unfolding from his sword tip.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship. Absolute Technique. Breaking the Sky Meteor Strike.

Sword qi that tore the sky flew toward Yoo Joonghyuk with a fearsome momentum. Yoo Joonghyuk avoided the baptism of sword qi by a hair's breadth. Our history flowed from his shoulder, which the sword qi grazed.

「"When that bastard Cheon Inho returns, deliver this to him."」

It was not a grand history. It was not the history of <Kim Dokja's Company> loved by countless Kim Dokjas, nor the story of 'Ways of Survival'. Nevertheless—

「"Are you truly Cheon Inho?"」

This was our story.

["How does it look to you?"]

It was purely the story of the 41st round.

「"I ask that Cheon Inho. Just who is 'Kim Dokja'?"」

The story of a world that was not written, and thus could not be read.

「"Could it be that you are 'Kim Dokja'?"」

We started from a snowfield where there was nothing and finally came all the way here.

「"■■■. That is his real name."」

[Your 'Super Giant Story' reacts to the character 'Yoo Joonghyuk'!]

As if to destroy that history, the great disaster's sword moved.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship (破天劍道). Secret Absolute Technique (秘傳奧義). Meteor Slash (流星斬).

The secret technique that killed Indra, the Lokapala of <Vedas>, unfolded from the great disaster's sword tip. Against the great disaster's sword strike that brought down the stars of the sky, Yoo Joonghyuk also thrust his spear.

Soul-Slaying Divine Spear (滅魂神槍). Secret Absolute Technique (秘傳奧義). Fall of Ten Thousand Stars (萬星墜落).

Two techniques created to bring down the stars of the night sky clashed. The moment the two stories collided with a dazzling flash of light, I saw the face of the great disaster.

Why was it, at that moment, the great disaster looking at us—

「had a gaze that seemed to miss something ancient.」

Perhaps because of that. I suddenly felt that I should not use this method on the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God'. But it was already too late.

The moment the flash of light flickered in the air, the left arm of the 41st round's Yoo Joonghyuk, severed by the Meteor Slash, flew through the air.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

But Yoo Joonghyuk did not back down. As if he had known from the start that his arm would be severed, he charged forward, penetrating the trajectory of the Meteor Slash to the end. Finally, the Dark Heavenly Moon Spear—pierced the disaster's flank.

「Thus, the record contained in the spearhead was realized.」

As if a predetermined poison was spreading, the record I crafted was infiltrating the great disaster's story.

「This is a poison effective only against 'regressors'.」

The great disaster, pierced by the spearhead, staggered and clutched his head. I was also hearing the voice echoing inside his head.

「"Yoo Joonghyuk. Did you protect everything you wanted to protect?"」

As the keyword of 'Regression Depression' activated, Yoo Joonghyuk's expression began to crumble. His story, carrying a distant history, began to weigh him down like a broken dam.

「A drowning human sinks deeper below the water's surface due to the weight of just a single feather.」

The knees of that noble great disaster slowly began to buckle.

「The only thing that can bring the Supreme King to his knees is the history he has lived.」

He stared blankly at the sky for a moment, then reached out with empty eyes. And in the next moment, stories exploded from his entire body.

"Yoo Joonghyuk!"

I shouted that name without even knowing which one I was calling. In the next moment, the screen shattered, and something pierced through the space-time of the Record Archive and popped out.

「It was a hand.」

The hand of a regressor who had repeated scenarios for a very long time. I struggled, caught in that strong hand. The character who had always been described in the story was speaking to me.

【Kim Dok ja】

The owner of the hand pulled me as I was. Along with a feeling as if the world was being erased, I was sucked straight to the outside of the 'Record Archive'.

Tzztzztzztzz!

I could not tell what was happening. Along with a feeling as if the surroundings were turned upside down, I gasped and opened my eyes. As if everything had been an illusion, the hand that had choked my neck was nowhere to be found.

Instead, what was visible before my eyes was a room so white it made my eyes smart. As I slowly raised my head—

「The Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,864th round was there.」

Yoo Joonghyuk was looking toward this side with his characteristic cold gaze, but he was not looking at me. In that instant, I realized something and turned back. There stood my brother, whom I knew well.

「"You've woken up, Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Snowfield Kim Dokja.

「"You bastard."」

Yoo Joonghyuk glared at Snowfield Kim Dokja with burning eyes, then looked back at the empty 'coffin' lying behind him. Only then did I realize. This was the memory of the 1,864th round's Yoo Joonghyuk.

「"Why did you release me?"」

This was the first proper conversation between the 1,864th round's Yoo Joonghyuk and Snowfield Kim Dokja.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1057 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (5)

Yoo Joonghyuk's voice toward Snowfield Kim Dokja carried a strange hostility. I examined the coffin where Yoo Joonghyuk had been lying until just now. Chills ran down my spine. This bastard Kim Dokja—don't tell me he was keeping Yoo Joonghyuk locked up here all this time.

「"He isn't someone who can be locked up just because you want to lock him up, is he?"」

As if reacting to my thoughts, Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke.

「"Would you like to have a cup of tea for a moment?"」

Snowfield Kim Dokja abruptly turned his back and walked toward the table in the center of the room. Looking at his defenelessly exposed back, Yoo Joonghyuk slowly raised his story. Did he feel that murderous intent? Snowfield Kim Dokja, who was walking ahead, stopped dead in his tracks and spoke.

「"I know you can cut me down right now. You have the power to do so."」

As if daring him to cut him down, he continued to speak without looking back.

「"But before that, aren't you also curious? Why I went out of my way to release you, and..."」

Yoo Joonghyuk approached Snowfield Kim Dokja step by step. Hearing the sound of his footsteps, Snowfield Kim Dokja added:

「"Why I drew you all in at the end of this worldline."」

The sound of Yoo Joonghyuk's footsteps stopped. Standing right behind Snowfield Kim Dokja, he was silent for a moment. Very slowly, Yoo Joonghyuk's murderous intent began to dissipate. Staring at Snowfield Kim Dokja with burning eyes, he soon passed by him and stepped into the empty room.

「He is right.」

Perhaps because I was inside Yoo Joonghyuk's memory, I could hear Yoo Joonghyuk's inner thoughts in real time.

「I can cut him down at any time.」

In the desolate white room, there were indeed a white tea table and two chairs. Yoo Joonghyuk stared down at the tea table.

「A tea table I have seen somewhere before.」

I also felt a strange sense of déjà vu as I looked down at the table. Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke.

「"It seems you recognize it. It's a product of the 73rd Demon Realm."」

The '73rd Demon Realm'. I heard that in this worldline, Snowfield Kim Dokja had already visited that Demon Realm. He must have liberated the Demon Realm in his own way there, and obtained a story fitting for it.

Snowfield Kim Dokja passed by the blankly standing Yoo Joonghyuk and sat in a chair.

「"It brings back old memories. Doesn't it?"」

「"Old memories?"」

As Kim Dokja lightly flicked his finger, two teacups appeared on the tea table. They were teacups I had also seen before.

「"Back then, we also drank tea like this in the Demon Realm. Have you forgotten?"」

I immediately realized what story Snowfield Kim Dokja was trying to tell. Once, when Kim Dokja fell into the 73rd Demon Realm, Yoo Joonghyuk had visited the 73rd Demon Realm to save him.

「Yoo Joonghyuk also remembered it.」

Immediately after defeating the Dukes of the Demon Realm and finishing the battle with Asmodeus, Yoo Joonghyuk visited Kim Dokja's hospital room. That day, Yoo Joonghyuk spoke a lot, which was unlike him. It was about the well-being of their companions after Kim Dokja left. He spoke about Lee Hyunsung, about Jung Heewon and Lee Jihye, about Yoo Sangah and Han Sooyoung, and about Gong Pildu, Shin Yoosung, and Lee Gilyoung.

「"Everyone is talking about you. You said so."」

Yoo Joonghyuk was silent for a moment. Very old memories were flowing through his mind.

「"Do they still talk about me a lot?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer. Then Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke once again.

「"Even back then, you said 'let's go back to Earth'. Just like not too long ago."」

Watching Snowfield Kim Dokja lightly sip the tea, I felt an indescribable sadness.

「"Are you still planning to take me 'home'?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk fell silent for a moment, then asked back instead of answering:

「"Where are our companions?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk slowly looked around. Faintly but surely, he could feel their companions' stories in his sensory perception.

「Our companions are definitely somewhere here.」

Yoo Joonghyuk clearly remembered the fierce battle with 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' not long ago. That they lost to Snowfield Kim Dokja was by no means because they were pushed back in status.

「They lost because of a certain story Snowfield Kim Dokja showed.」

The moment they saw that story, everyone in <Kim Dokja's Company> trembled, despaired, and at the same time, resigned.

「"They are in a safe place."」

「"Bring them here."」

「"That is difficult."」

Yoo Joonghyuk raised his status without a word. The tea in the cup trembled violently.

「"At least, the Kim Dokja I know doesn't do things like this."」

「"Things like this?"」

「"That guy—"」

「"A person who can use the party members as tools to achieve the purpose he wants."」

In a voice imbued with a subtle twist, Snowfield Kim Dokja continued.

「"A person who doesn't care about the wounds his companions will receive just to complete the conclusion of the story he wants to see. The 'Kim Dokja' I know is that kind of person."」

Yoo Joonghyuk could not reply. Perhaps it was because Snowfield Kim Dokja's words were true to some extent. Kim Dokja's gaze is lonely. Even when he is with his companions, he ultimately sees the conclusion of this world alone. Yoo Joonghyuk had also felt that fact all along. In fact, in that sense, the 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' before his eyes resembled the Kim Dokja he knew.

「"You have no right to say such words."」

Yoo Joonghyuk cut him off with a cold expression, as if he had no intention of listening further. Then Kim Dokja asked:

「"Why do I have no right?"」

「"You—"」

「"So you also know. That the 'Kim Dokja' you were looking for is not me."」

「"I will count to three. Bring our companions within that time."」

Before he knew it, the 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword' was held in Yoo Joonghyuk's right hand. Staring at the story dwelling in that 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword', Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke.

「"I will also count to three."」

「"What?"」

「"If you don't sit in that chair within three counts, you will lose your companions forever."」

There was no way the Yoo Joonghyuk I knew would yield to such a threat. Nevertheless, Snowfield Kim Dokja counted.

"Three."

Yoo Joonghyuk stared silently at that Kim Dokja.

"Two."

Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body was becoming even more fierce.

"One."

An explosive status surged from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body as if he would tear the Kim Dokja before him to pieces right away. And in the next moment, all of Yoo Joonghyuk's murderous intent scattered like magic. Watching Yoo Joonghyuk collapse into the chair, Snowfield Kim Dokja laughed.

「"Are you afraid of losing your companions?"」

「"I know you won't do such a thing."」

「"How do you know that? I am—"」

「"Because you are also 'Kim Dokja'."」

Snowfield Kim Dokja was silent for a moment. Picking up the teacup with his long fingers, he drank down the remaining tea. Then, frowning as if displeased, he retorted:

「"Did you think I would be touched if you said that?"」

「"What is it that you want?"」

Yoo Joonghyuk asked straightforwardly, as if he would drag time no longer. However, I could tell that his question was a sort of smokescreen. Because even while they conversed, Yoo Joonghyuk's sensory perception was expanding in real time. He was searching for his companions by tracing back the story of Snowfield Kim Dokja that dominated this entire area.

Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke.

「"You already know what I want. Because what I want resembles what you once wanted."」

「"I remember the story you showed."」

The reason Yoo Joonghyuk and the party members had no choice but to be captured helplessly. Recalling the story he saw that day, Yoo Joonghyuk asked:

「"Just what on earth was that?"」

What Yoo Joonghyuk witnessed that day was the essence of this world. The 'certain conclusion' shaped by the 41st round—no, perhaps by all the universes of this <Star Stream>.

「"That is—"」

「"Shh. That story is not written yet."」

As if someone might listen, Snowfield Kim Dokja said, bringing a finger to his lips.

「"That story is what the writer who wrote the first sentence of this story left for me."」

The writer who wrote the first sentence of the story. Yoo Joonghyuk also knew who that was.

「"If you saw that story, you would know that in the end, it is not bad for you either. Because when that story is completed, the 'single Kim Dokja' you search for so much will also return."」

「"The single Kim Dokja."」

Yoo Joonghyuk muttered, as if speaking the name of an old ghost.

「"We also know that is impossible—"」

「"Do not lie."」

'Snowfield Kim Dokja' shot back sharply.

「"If you really thought that was impossible, you wouldn't have come here."」

Yoo Joonghyuk did not answer his anger. Satisfied with that silence, Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke.

「"What I want is simple. You drinking the tea placed before you. That is all I want."」

Yoo Joonghyuk looked down at his teacup shimmering on the tea table.

「"Drink that tea, and save me just as you saved Kim Dokja in the Demon Realm."」

It was at that moment that the presence of the party members was felt by Yoo Joonghyuk's sensory perception. Surprisingly, their companions had already been released just like him. And with a somewhat dazed appearance, they were waiting for something in a room that looked identical to this space.

Yoo Joonghyuk asked, gritting his teeth:

「"Just what on earth did you do to our companions?"」

「"I only fed them tea."」

「"What does that—"」

「"None of them drank that tea by force. And now you are the last."」

Along with his words, stories began to cry inside the teacup. A very old wolf's roar heard from somewhere. Yoo Joonghyuk realized what was contained in the tea. The moment he sprang up from his seat, Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke.

「"Swallow it, Yoo Joonghyuk."」

Like a modifier commanding its incarnation, 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was speaking. Along with a tzztzztzz sound, a certain binding force began to control Yoo Joonghyuk's body.

「"Become the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' for me—"」

As if possessed by something, Yoo Joonghyuk's right hand moved toward the teacup.

「"And destroy this worldline."」

At the moment his hand finally grasped the teacup, Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth.

「"I."」

Yoo Joonghyuk's burning eyes stared at 'Snowfield Kim Dokja'.

「"Will not drink the tea."」

A voice as firm as the day he first refused 'regression'. But as if mocking such a regressor's will, Snowfield Kim Dokja spoke.

「"If you don't drink that tea, you will never reclaim 'Kim Dokja'."」

Along with a tzztzztzz sound, Yoo Joonghyuk's right hand began to tremble once again.

「"The memories of his old companions were calling him."」

What was contained in the teacup was not just the story of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God'.

「Inside that teacup was the 'Kim Dokja' he remembered.」

Why did Kim Dokja have to choose to become the 'Oldest Dream'? Why didn't Kim Dokja give them a choice until the very end? Why did Kim Dokja have to start all these stories once again even though he knew the consequences the scenario would bring?

「"I—"」

Yoo Joonghyuk only then realized the reason why the party members had no choice but to drink this tea. All the history they had accumulated soon became a [Fate], binding them.

「Ultimately, all stories are already written, and at the same time, are being written.」

Yoo Joonghyuk muttered the name of the writer who wrote their records.

「"Han Sooyoung."」

As if his body refused his control, his right hand moved.

「"Just why."」

That was the end. At the moment the tea was sucked into Yoo Joonghyuk's mouth as if swirling, the light in Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes went out.

I even knew that I could not change this memory, but I reached out my hand toward Yoo Joonghyuk. Of course, my hand did not reach him. And Snowfield Kim Dokja simply looked on at all those moments with silent eyes. And he spoke:

"There's no need to feel so sorry. It's already a written story. There is nothing you can do in this memory."

I started, turning to look at Snowfield Kim Dokja.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja is here.」

The 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' in the memory was looking at me. Only then did I also realize. The moment I entered this 'memory', Snowfield Kim Dokja had also entered here.

I spoke to Snowfield Kim Dokja.

"But the story that will unfold from now on is a story that has not been written yet."

At my words, Snowfield Kim Dokja laughed.

"Yeah."

My heart beat loudly, and Yoo Joonghyuk's memory began to scatter. In the faintly rising scenery of the battlefield, only two people knew what would happen from now on.

「There were two Yoo Joonghyuks there, and two Kim Dokjas watching them.」

We activated the same skill at the same time.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is activated!]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1058 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (6)

Along with dazzling sparks, the surroundings began to undulate.

[Activation conditions for exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' have been met!]

Fortunately, I was in a state where I had satisfied all the core activation conditions for [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]. One was for me to pass out. And two was for the caster and the target of the skill to think of each other at the same time.

[Your level of understanding of the target character is extremely high!]

['1st Person Protagonist's Point of View' is activated!]

However, even though the conditions were successfully met, I could not lower my guard. Because this [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] was just that special.

「Never in history had 'two Kim Dokjas' possessed 'two Yoo Joonghyuks' at the same time.」

An event that could not happen in the original story because the premise itself was impossible. That event was unfolding right before my eyes.

「Which 'Yoo Joonghyuk' will I possess?」

Gradually, the body's senses began to revive. They were not the senses of my own physical body.

「I felt the incarnation body of the protagonist of this vibrant world—a Transcendent—assimilating with my senses.」

The moment I felt the sleeve of my left arm was empty, I realized which Yoo Joonghyuk I had possessed.

The 41st round. I thought it would be troublesome if the possession went wrong, but thankfully it didn't.

As I blinked, I saw Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,864th round standing at a distance with a hardened expression. Leaking stories from one shoulder, he was still sweeping through the aftermath while frowning.

"Did you return?"

Along with 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk's voice, I nodded and asked.

- Yes. Did you happen to see it as well?

"Vaguely."

It seemed 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk also caught a glimpse of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God's memories with me. Clenching and unclenching his single remaining right hand, he briefly inspected his incarnation body.

"You possessed me. Is it the same state as back then?"

- That's right. You remember.

Just once, I had used [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] on 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk to trigger the '1st Person Protagonist's Point of View'.

「During the final battle of the 40th round inside the Realm of Fear's time fault.」

Fighting against the Constellations there, I had briefly possessed Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation body.

[The target character is rejecting your control.]

As expected, just like back then, Yoo Joonghyuk was rejecting my control this time as well. Honestly, it didn't matter. Right now Yoo Joonghyuk's mind was clear, and I wasn't used to fighting with Yoo Joonghyuk's body anyway. The important thing was that from now on, I could manifest the stories I possessed through Yoo Joonghyuk's incarnation body.

"Is the other side in the same state?"

I answered while looking at Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,864th round, who was still engulfed in sparks a dozen steps away.

- We don't know yet.

Just as I possessed 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk, Snowfield Kim Dokja must have also tried to possess 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk. But would it really go as smoothly as he thought?

「'1st Person Protagonist's Point of View' requires a certain level of understanding of the target character.」

What does it truly mean for one person to understand another? Even I, who had overcome scenarios alongside 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk, wouldn't dare say I fully understood Yoo Joonghyuk—so could Snowfield Kim Dokja properly possess a sufficient level of understanding toward 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk?

Kugugugugu.

In the distance, 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk was seen slowly opening his eyes. The moment I read the pale story swirling in his eyes, both Yoo Joonghyuk and I realized at the same time.

"That is—"

From his entire body, the stories of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' were flowing out.

「"Regression changes nothing. It took a very long time to realize that."」

To be precise, it was the story regarding Yoo Joonghyuk that 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' had read.

「"Because in this turn, there are companions who will not betray me."」

Understanding is one-way. All understanding is granted without the other person's consent.

「"I am Yoo Joonghyuk. The regressor, Yoo Joonghyuk."」

That was the product of reading and re-reading a single story over and over again.

「"Joonghyuk-ah, we can save the world. You know that, right?"」

Pung! With a popping sound, the surrounding sparks disappeared all at once. The facial muscles of 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk moved grotesquely, and soon his lips slowly opened.

【Ah—】

The moment I heard that voice, I knew.

「It is not Yoo Joonghyuk.」

My brother, who had completely dominated a soul through ruthless reading and finally stood in the place closest to the 'Oldest Dream', was right there.

【Finally, this moment has come.】

Snowfield Kim Dokja dwelling in the strongest incarnation body was speaking through Yoo Joonghyuk's mouth. Judging from his state, he seemed to have forcefully put Yoo Joonghyuk's soul to sleep before descending here. Probably for that reason, he fed tea to Yoo Joonghyuk and manipulated his stories.

【My brother.】

As if extremely delighted by this confrontation, Snowfield Kim Dokja smiled brightly with Yoo Joonghyuk's face. In the midst of a stomach-churning sense of incongruity, just as I was about to reply something, his expression suddenly changed.

【Wait.】

It was at that moment that thunderbolts struck out of the clear sky. Lightning plunging from somewhere struck 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body. Fierce electric shocks repeating several times. It strongly resembled—Breaking the Sky Sword Lightning (破天劍雷).

The sword lightning fell from the sky again and again, driving into 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk. I stared blankly at the sword lightning scorching Yoo Joonghyuk black. Listening to the roaring sound of the 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword' held in his hand, I realized what had happened late.

「That sword lightning was driven into himself directly by Yoo Joonghyuk himself.」

*

Snowfield Kim Dokja opened his eyes with a blank expression.

"Ah."

Was it due to the shock of electrocution? His vision did not brighten clearly. Along with a faint headache, looking around, the scenery of the familiar white room came into view at a glance. An empty chair placed forlornly opposite, and a tea table with cooled tea.

He stared blankly down at the teacup on the table, then reached into his chest like a person who suddenly remembered something. A moment later, a book was held in his hand.

『Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.』

The story that was now completely worn out from being read over and over again was right there. He grew up reading that story continuously in the lonely snowfield.

"As expected, it doesn't work."

A hollow, bitter smile. A system message floating before his eyes was seen.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' has been forcibly deactivated!]

[Your level of understanding of the target character is insufficient.]

In the end, he could not understand 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk. Perhaps it was because 'Yoo Joonghyuk' had now become an existence that could no longer be caught up to solely through his reading.

Even after manipulating stories, feeding the disaster's story, and even using Kim Dokja's story—

「1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk did not allow his 'viewpoint'.」

Snowfield Kim Dokja drank the cooled tea with a bitter smile. And he muttered.

"Understood, Yoo Joonghyuk. If that is your will."

As his long fingers flipped the pages, the last page of the book opened in an instant. A blank page with nothing written on it. Soon, stories began to rise above the page. On top of that blank page, the final battle of Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk was beginning.

"However, whatever choice you make."

Snowfield Kim Dokja reached his finger out over the page and said.

"You cannot change the conclusion of this story."

*

Even after the Probability aftermath vanished, 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk stood motionless as if frozen.

"An opportunity."

The one who moved instead was 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk. Grasping the 'Dark Heavenly Moon Spear' with his single remaining right hand, he immediately launched a strike of the Soul Extinguishing Divine Spear. If someone saw it, they might have called it a cowardly attack. But Yoo Joonghyuk didn't think so.

41st round Yoo Joonghyuk was instinctively realizing it.

「If we don't pour out all our strength right now, there will be no chance to kill him again.」

Soul Extinguishing Divine Spear. Secret esoteric technique. The moment Yoo Joonghyuk's spear strike concentrating stories shot out like lightning—the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' who bounded forward using [Red Phoenix Shunpo] grabbed the tip of the Dark Heavenly Moon Spear.

Kugugugugu!

The stories of the two Yoo Joonghyuks collided at the spear tip, causing a thunderous roar. Clearly, the Probability aftermath was no longer raging. The momentum of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was also not felt from the disaster's incarnation body. That made it clear.

「Snowfield Kim Dokja failed to activate 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint'.」

The one right before our eyes right now was the pure 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk himself. If so, the situation was not bad for us.

"What—"

Clearly, it shouldn't have been bad. Frowning while letting out a groan, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk raised his status. But no matter how much he raised his status, it was difficult to withstand the story pressure that 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk continuously spewed out before his eyes.

Looking at the confrontation between those two existences, I recalled a conversation from long ago.

「Who is the strongest Yoo Joonghyuk?」

I don't remember exactly when it was. Probably in the early scenarios. Cha Sungwoo, Cha Yerin, Yehyeonwoo, and the other readers—back when we didn't fully realize what kind of tragedy we had entered. The readers once engaged in a conversation on such a topic as an icebreaker.

「"As expected, the strongest is the 'Secretive Plotter'."」

Perhaps those were Cha Sungwoo's words.

「"What are you talking about? The strongest is the 1,864th round. That side won in the end."」

Then Yehyeonwoo said,

「"Could the 999th round unexpectedly be strong as well?"」

And Kyung Sein raised a question,

「"According to my daughter, in terms of sheer talent alone, the 0th round is the most outstanding."」

Uncle Dansu also added a word. The one who ended that debate was Cha Yerin, who had been listening to their conversation in silence. As Cha Yerin, who rarely opened her mouth, began to state her opinion, the surrounding attention focused on her.

「"The strongest Yoo Joonghyuk is..."」

Slowly opening his eyes, the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' was looking at me.

[Great disaster, 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', reveals its status!]

Without anyone's help, purely with his own specs alone, he was surpassing the status of 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk and me using [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint].

It was an impossible thing. I had gathered nearly half of the 'Kim Dokja fragments', and 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk had also become strong enough to kill a Myth-grade Constellation. Even if it was 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk, how could he be more than our combined status—

"Kim Dokja."

For the first time, tension was felt in the voice of the 41st round, who had been confident all along.

"You said that guy saw the end of the scenario in the 1,864th round."

- Yes.

The moment I answered that question, I recalled Cha Yerin's answer regarding the 'strongest Yoo Joonghyuk'.

「"'Yoo Joonghyuk who restarted the regression that had stopped'."」

I felt as if someone pressed the switch of the world with a click sound.

"If so, why—"

I understood the doubt possessed by 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk. Because I too was seeing the exact same scenery through his eyes.

**[Exclusive Attribute: Regressor <1,865th round>]**

Yoo Joonghyuk's regression turn had changed.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1059 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (7)

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Why was the notation '1,865th round' written in the attribute window of Yoo Joonghyuk, who saw the end of the scenario in the 1,864th round? Unable to bring myself to answer Yoo Joonghyuk's question, I read that number with a bewildered heart.

「Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th round.」

I remembered the appearance of that Yoo Joonghyuk.

「"Do you think that if you run once more, you will be able to see it clearly?"」

The man who, even after witnessing the conclusion of such a terrible scenario, walked into tragedy once again.

"Because he is the only Yoo Joonghyuk in this universe who has seen the end of the scenario 'twice'."

[Constellations hiding all over the battlefield reveal their starlight!]

The stars that had been hiding in the battlefield until now revealed themselves in the sky. It was inevitable. Any Constellation who saw the Yoo Joonghyuk before their eyes right now would have no choice but to shine their starlight upon him.

[Outer Gods across the scenario feel a solemn thrill at the descent of that existence!]

The disasters following him were also paying homage to him from all over.

[Some 'Gods of Other Worlds' wish to offer their stories and take refuge in him!]

It was not just the great disasters of Ragnarok.

【O o o o o o o】

The 'Gods of Other Worlds' who remembered him from participating in the Great War of Saints and Demons and Journey to the West were roaring simultaneously.

【The existence closest to the Secretive Plotter than anyone else】

The colors of the sky changed several times, and a massive storm of Probability aftermath swept the area.

「All these universes were expressing awe to him.」

Gods from all over the universe looked into Yoo Joonghyuk and paid respect to his tragedy. He had the right to be so.

"He saw the end twice?"

At Yoo Joonghyuk's question, I nodded. Two conclusions. I could write that sentence, but I did not know exactly what that sentence meant. However, just as Kim Dokja did, I simply transcribed the life he had lived and came all the way here.

"Yes."

Without that Yoo Joonghyuk, without the stories of the 1,865th round that he showed, I wouldn't have reached the final scenario of the 41st round.

"Why did he do such a thing?"

"Because he had to save someone."

In the end, he reached the conclusion of a world once again. Solely with the single heart to save just one person. And now he is here.

[The great disaster, 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', reveals its true status!]

Just existing in the same space gave a feeling as if the heart was stopping. An existence that saw the end twice. On top of that, Yoo Joonghyuk, who obtained the stage effect of a

'great disaster', was literally a monster.

"You must know that there is almost no chance of winning on our side."

At Yoo Joonghyuk's groaning voice, I could not hide my tension either. Until now, I thought 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was our greatest adversary. But the moment I saw that Yoo Joonghyuk, I thought that perhaps I had misjudged. Right now, we might be facing an existence in all these worlds that should never be made an enemy.

"We don't know yet."

If so, there was only one way.

"Yoo Joonghyuk. Please let me speak through your mouth for a moment."

"What?"

Perhaps this might be the last chance.

「Right now, that Yoo Joonghyuk is in a state of rejecting the Snowfield's control.」

Judging from past memories, the Yoo Joonghyuk before our eyes right now was not in a favorable state toward Snowfield Kim Dokja. In such a situation, what if we could turn him to our side?

"No—"

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."

[Exclusive skill, 'Incite Lv.?' is activated!]

I forcibly seized Yoo Joonghyuk's right to speak. Though I could hear Yoo Joonghyuk pouring curses at me inside my head, now was not the time to care about that.

"Yoo Joonghyuk."

When I called that name, the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' looked at me. I could see his eyes wavering faintly. I opened my mouth again.

"Do you know who I am?"

The Wolf That Swallowed a God looked at me with a strange gaze, then moved his head ever so slightly. It was a small gesture, but even that alone made my heart beat loudly. He

was definitely aware of my existence.

"We don't need to fight."

The gaze of the Wolf That Swallowed a God was extremely unstable. To reassure him, I opened my mouth repeatedly.

"I know what you came here for."

The purpose of <Kim Dokja's Company>, including Yoo Joonghyuk, was clear.

「Their purpose is to reclaim their 'Kim Dokja'.」

A hundred percent Kim Dokja. To reclaim that existence, which now sounds like an illusion, they have endured all time.

"The single Kim Dokja definitely exists. I believe so."

I do not know what kind of world conclusion 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' showed to <Kim Dokja's Company>. But whatever he saw, I could not let the conclusion flow as my brother wanted.

"I will help you."

I knew that a normal request would not turn his heart. Also, if I used a clumsy [Incite], it would incur great anger instead. If so.

"I will somehow rewrite your conclusion 'again'."

[The Recorder of Fear, 'One Who Rewrites Eternity', declares!]

At my oath, the disaster's gaze looking at me changed. He looked into me with serious eyes as if reading the story dwelling inside me. And he spoke.

【Kim Dokja.】

When he called my name, it felt strange. Was it because I was facing a great existence I had never met face-to-face before? Barely enduring a faint dizziness, I listened to his words.

【This story cannot be stopped.】

I could not understand. Why was that 'Yoo Joonghyuk' of all people saying such a thing? I retorted as if resisting [Fate].

"I know why you are standing there. Probably Snowfield Kim Dokja—'Snow White' persuaded you. But—"

Right now, the presence of 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' was not felt from Yoo Joonghyuk. Even if 'Snowfield Kim Dokja' intervened, if it was Yoo Joonghyuk who could use the power of the 1,865th round, he would be able to shake off that dominance. If so, the Yoo Joonghyuk over there right now was standing there of his own pure will.

"You also know what will happen if Snowfield Kim Dokja becomes the 'single Kim Dokja', don't you?"

I spoke with earnestness.

"If he becomes the 'single Kim Dokja', this worldline will be destroyed."

【It is a history already written.】

The sentiment of Yoo Joonghyuk returning was colder than expected. Did a feeling of backlash arise at that response? Words blurted out of me involuntarily.

"Didn't you guys already twist the history that was written?"

Perhaps those words were something that should never have been said to Yoo Joonghyuk who experienced the 1,865th round.

「Y o u g u y s r u i n e d t h e e n d i n g a n d w i l l b e c o m e u n h a p p y」

A story echoing emptily in his memory. Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th round spoke.

【That is why everything went wrong.】

A voice like a very old sigh. At the feeling of despair dwelling in that voice, I bit my lower lip several times. Was Yoo Joonghyuk regretting it? Having undergone a 'group regression' once again with his companions. Jumping into the 1,865th round. Repeating all that history to save Kim Dokja—was he perhaps regretting it?

"You were not wrong."

I spoke, staring into his sadly distorted eyes.

"Just because you reached an unwanted conclusion doesn't mean that the entire process was wrong. You did your best. You..."

Even if Kim Dokja could not return to them, Kim Dokja must have read their story. He must have read and reread that history of struggle, the stories of the people who loved him. And he would have been happy. But the current me could not fully prove that story.

「Because I was not the 'single Kim Dokja' who could fully convey those words.」

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th round looked at me with dark eyes and spoke.

【If you are right.】

As if further conversation was useless, his hand grasped the 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword'.

【You just have to prove it.】

When the great disaster's sword moved, for an instant, it felt as if the world was being crushed. If the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round had not reclaimed control of his body in time, I would have fainted on the spot, unable to withstand the shock.

Kuddddeuk!

A strike as if bending space-time. For a moment, the curved Dark Heavenly Moon Spear barely blocked that strike.

"Now you must know. He is a guy who cannot be communicated with through conversation."

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round spoke, gritting his teeth. Toward us, the great disaster was walking.

「I thought conversation might not work.」

I simply wanted to pin my hopes on it. I wanted to find a way to avoid the scheduled tragedy. But as always, scenarios usually flow only in the worst direction. Perhaps because this is the story this world wants.

Rumbleeee!

The great disaster slowly raising his status. Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round nervously called me.

"Kim Dokja—"

"It can't be helped."

"What?"

I hoped that this development alone would not come to pass. Hoping a miracle unwritten anywhere would occur, so that this 'stage' alone would not unfold.

"The time has come now."

The gloomy sky brightened radiantly. Then, along with a roaring sound, thunderbolts fell from the sky. A story of pure electric lightning with a brightness equal to, or perhaps greater than, Yoo Joonghyuk's Breaking the Sky Sword Lightning. It was a strike that even the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' had to raise his sword to defend against.

「I thought he would definitely come.」

He was an existence possessing the core story of this 'Ragnarok'. And one of the protagonists of this 'Ragnarok'.

[The Master of the Giant Nebula, <Asgard>, reveals his story!]

Even though he was a star I disliked so much, his appearance was welcome this time.

"You—"

Seeing the star that descended beside us with thunderbolts, Yoo Joonghyuk opened his eyes wide.

[Constellation, 'All-Father' has descended upon the area!]

'All-Father' Odin.

[Stand back, Einherjar. That wolf's opponent is me.]

Stories rising softly from his entire body began to cover the surrounding battlefield. Like flowers blooming enchantingly, the entire night sky transformed into a cluster blooming flowers of lightning.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' begins its storytelling.]

A landscape that even I, who had already witnessed the stories of countless Myth-grade Constellations, could not help but admire.

「This is the first story of 'Ragnarok'.」

Finally, the time had come to recreate the stage of 'Ragnarok'.

「A storm of lightning was raging in the surrounding space-time.」

Every time Odin walked forward step by step, his body grew larger and larger. A Myth-grade Constellation. His true body, claiming to be the strongest in the <Star Stream> alongside Zeus of <Olympus>, was revealing itself on the battlefield.

At that moment, Odin's transmission pierced into my ears.

[I have one request.]

As I looked at his back, a transmission came once again.

[Please keep the items on the table safe for me.]

A voice as if foreseeing the end of this story. I nodded and replied.

"Understood."

As if that was enough, Odin stood in front of the 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk.

「Finally, the 'All-Father' looked at the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God'.」

In response to his story, a wolf-shaped aura was wavering from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

[Fighting with you is the second time now.]

This was the scheduled battlefield of myth. Recognizing him, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th round frowned.

【Did you crawl here on your own feet because you want to die?】

It seemed the two existences had already engaged in a fierce battle once. As the lightning-shaped scar remaining on Yoo Joonghyuk's neck emitted a pure white light, a red glow hovered over the sword scars covering Odin's upper body. The wounds inflicted on each other's incarnation bodies were resonating with each other's stories.

[It is time to settle the match from back then.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1060 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (8)

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As if mocking Odin's declaration, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression swung the 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword'. The moment the regressor's sword, perfected through endless training, touched the god's neck, Odin's single eye flared with light.

「He is the one who killed the primordial giant.」

The space around us warped, and Yoo Joonghyuk's slash vanished somewhere. I was startled by that astonishing power.

「Together with his brothers he claimed the first void and opened a myth with the corpse of that giant.」

Others might not know, but I alone knew what that power was.

[The Giant Story 'Ginnungagap' has begun its storytelling.]

Ginnungagap. The primordial power that <Asgard> had once used to deal with me and the 'Demon King of Salvation'. That powerful force was now being manifested by Odin alone.

Yoo Joonghyuk paid no mind to the disappearing slash and continued pouring out attacks.

[It is useless. O 'Outer God who searches for the Oldest Dream'!]

Every time a slash flew in, the void space of 'Ginnungagap' opened and closed repeatedly.

A power that nullified every single terrifying slash of the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression.

I knew Odin was a strong constellation. I had experienced it in the 40th regression, read about it in the main story, and even witnessed his battle against the Great Sage Heaven's Equal with my own eyes.

But the moment I looked at the Odin before me, I felt that I still did not truly know him.

「Only he would understand both the beginning and the end of a single myth.」

He was the existence who had killed Ymir, the master of <Asgard>'s Primordial Void (太虛) — 'Ginnungagap' — and become a god himself.

An unusual and ominous aura flickered in both of his hands as he wielded the void dimension of 'Ginnungagap'.

Black and white stories resided in Odin's hands. The right hand resembled pitch black darkness, and the left hand resembled pure white light. Those two hands that grasped the void were precisely the power that differentiated him from other 'Myth-grade Constellations'.

「Odin's right hand — the 'Primordial Will', Vili.」

I sensed the immense power of the stories dwelling in those two hands.

「Odin's left hand — the 'Divider of Order', Vé.」

The power of those two stars was also the source that had placed Odin upon the throne of <Asgard>.

「He devoured his own brothers and claimed the title of Master of the Primordial Void.」

The Trinity of Will, Order, and Wisdom.

Faced with Odin's might, who alone exercised a status equivalent to the combined power of three 'Myth-grade Constellations', I forgot even to breathe as I became absorbed in the battlefield.

Goosebumps continuously rose along my spine. There were two reasons. The first was pure astonishment at Odin's status, and the second was—

"Even a monster that powerful fled from 'Snow White', huh."

Hearing Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression's voice, I nodded.

The enemy we would have to fight from now on was a monster that made even that Myth-grade Constellation tremble in fear.

And another monster who did not fear such an Odin stood right before our eyes.

【What a vulgar story.】

The Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression. Using [Red Phoenix Shunpo] that had reached its absolute limit, he closed the distance and began unleashing slashes from a range far closer than before.

Odin moved both hands in a flurry and absorbed the slashes into the void dimension.

Yet Yoo Joonghyuk seemed not to care about such minor issues and began swinging his sword at an even greater speed. In the chain of slashes that had become fast enough to distort even space and time, suddenly Yoo Joonghyuk's sword momentum changed, and Odin's expression, previously composed, began to twist little by little.

Shooting Star Slash.

A trajectory of death that no star could evade flew toward Odin's neck. But Odin, as if he had anticipated even that, unleashed a story.

「He stood before endless destruction and never ceased his obsession with infinite knowledge and martial power.」

His single eye that saw the future was reading the trajectory of the Shooting Star Slash.

A strike he barely managed to dodge. But the attack did not end there.

Shooting Star Slash — Two Consecutive Strikes.

The slash that could cut down even Myth-grade Constellations increased to two. Toward the flying slashes, Odin blew a long whistle. Then a flock of crows that covered the sky appeared from somewhere.

Kkaaaaawww!

The crows soon melted like black paint and poured down onto the ground. The black paint erased the entire landscape of the area and even swallowed the Shooting Star Slashes. Within that metaphysical landscape, Odin spoke in his true voice.

[This is my stage! No matter who you are, here you cannot defeat m—]

Shooting Star Slash — Three Consecutive Strikes.

As a slash several times larger than before came crashing down, a look of bewilderment appeared on Odin's face as well.

Perhaps blocking the attacks was gradually becoming overwhelming. He avoided the first slash, barely blocked the second, but the third slash grazed his shoulder. Yoo Joonghyuk did not miss that opening.

Shooting Star Slash — Four Consecutive Strikes.

Odin's single eye trembled violently. He urgently waved both hands and summoned a massive void dimension.

As the void dimension that absorbed even starlight swirled like a black hole, every single one of Yoo Joonghyuk's furiously flying slashes vanished beyond 'Ginnungagap'. Since Ginnungagap was a 'Dimension Before Records', any slash that entered it inevitably lost its power and was dismantled.

Yet even knowing that fact, Yoo Joonghyuk did not stop attacking. And something unbelievable occurred.

Shooting Star Slash — Five Consecutive Strikes.

The moment the five trajectories were sucked into the void dimension, a crack appeared for the first time at the entrance of 'Ginnungagap'.

[What—]

The void dimension that had absorbed the slashes was suffering.

「There is no tragedy that Ginnungagap cannot digest.」

The history of a regressor who had turned back time again and again. The slash carrying that story was advancing while shattering even the void itself.

Shooting Star Slash — Six Consecutive Strikes.

The collapse of Ginnungagap's entrance and Odin's scream occurred at almost the same time.

[How dare you—]

The slashes continued, deeply cutting his right hand and left hand, his abdomen, both of his legs, and then his chest.

[GHAAAAHHH!]

Odin's incarnation body was being torn to pieces. Even after mercilessly severing Vili dwelling in Odin's right hand and Vé in his left, the Shooting Star Slash did not stop.

Shooting Star Slash — Seven Consecutive Strikes.

As if determined to shred every story of that star to pieces, the Shooting Star Slash carved out even Odin's scream. Odin's empty eyes blinked. The moment the tattered Odin slowly sank to his knees, Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword' pierced through Odin's heart.

「A great myth was collapsing right before their eyes.」

The strange thing, however, was Odin's expression. Even in the moment facing his end, Odin was smiling while gripping the blade of Yoo Joonghyuk's 'Black Heavenly Demon Sword'.

「He is the god who offered nine lives over nine nights while pierced by a spear.」

In that instant, Odin's story flashed through my mind.

「He offered himself as a sacrifice upon the World Tree 'Yggdrasil' and glimpsed the 'First Record'.」

Odin's incarnation body was enveloped in dazzling rays of light. The moment the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression hesitated, the story that flowed from Odin's entire body grew like chains and bound Yoo Joonghyuk's whole body. Frowning, Yoo Joonghyuk tried to shake them off. But he could not cut the story chains.

「The magical chain Gleipnir.」

It was a star relic that Odin possessed. Yet no matter how great a star relic it was, it should not have been able to control Yoo Joonghyuk. Under normal circumstances, that should have been the case.

「There are three ways to survive in a ruined world.」

If only it had not been for the story dwelling in the Disaster.

「I have already forgotten some of them by now.」

It was the story of 'Ways of Survival'.

Odin, resurrected within the rays of light, gripped the chain that bound Yoo Joonghyuk as if holding a leash.

[You foolish Disaster. Did you truly think I would be defeated?]

Yoo Joonghyuk unleashed an even more powerful status to try to release the story chains, but the chains only tightened more strongly around his entire body.

「It was a leash created solely to control a single disaster.」

Odin spoke with a faint smile.

[Give up. This is the leash meant to bind the Wolf of Disaster.]

Within the story of 'Ragnarok', 'Gleipnir' was the star relic that bound the disaster Fenrir.

As long as Yoo Joonghyuk from the 1,865th regression had descended as the 'Wolf That Swallowed God', he could not escape this restraint.

[This is the great 'Ragnarok'. No matter what you do, you cannot undo this lea—]

Accompanied by fierce sparks, a Probability storm began raging from Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

【Do you—】

Part of Gleipnir was composed of the story of 'Ways of Survival' that Odin had obtained. And 'Ways of Survival' was the birth story that constituted Yoo Joonghyuk himself. Therefore, it should have been impossible for Yoo Joonghyuk to sever that 'Story' with his own power.

【—think this is the first time I face you?】

That would have been the case only if he had been the Yoo Joonghyuk of 'Ways of Survival'.

Gleipnir's binding, which should never have been broken, began to snap.

「He was the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression. The protagonist of the story who had gone beyond 'Ways of Survival' and finally walked out of that stage.」

Odin's eyes began to widen as he confirmed the story flowing throughout Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

The Myth-grade Constellation who had witnessed a story he had never seen before shook his head and stepped backward instinctively.

[The Story 'Terror of Asgard' has begun its storytelling.]

It was the exclusive story of Yoo Joonghyuk who cleared the scenarios of the 1,865th regression.

[How can you possess that story—]

Throwing the powerless, broken chains onto the ground, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression slowly rose to his feet.

【This is not the first time I'm going to kill you.】

The moment the 'Wolf That Swallowed God' unleashed his status, Odin also prepared for the final battle.

As the statuses of the two beings collided, a pitch black night descended upon the area.

「This was an event whose ending was already predetermined.」

Suffocating silence covered the battlefield. The 'Nameless Ones' that had been lingering nearby, drawn by Yoo Joonghyuk's story, could not endure the story pressure of the two existences that suddenly crashed down and exploded. Within that horrific feast, only I and the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression foresaw the conclusion of this story.

"We have to help Odin."

— No.

Without taking my eyes off Odin and the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression, I spoke.

— You know it too, don't you? How this battle ends.

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression did not answer. He also knew.

— This is the only way we can win.

A story was boiling within the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression. It was the story of 'Vidar, the Ender of Wars', whom he had once killed.

「The myth of 'Ragnarok' was being reenacted.」

Within the pitch black night sky, Odin's beloved steed 'Sleipnir' could be seen galloping across space. Odin mounted his steed and gripped his exclusive weapon. A spear that spat flames of light (光炎).

The Divine Spear Gungnir.

Containing the story of <Asgard>, it was the spear that had tormented Yoo Joonghyuk and <Kim Dokja Company> again and again in the past.

Facing that spear, Yoo Joonghyuk also drew his Black Heavenly Demon Sword.

If he had been the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression, it would have been difficult to overwhelm Odin with pure martial power alone. But the current him was different.

Right now he was an incarnation who had seen the conclusion twice, a regressor who had reached the final point of regression. And—

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship (破天劍道).

Secret Technique: Inner Mystery Transmission (超越奧義).

—the disaster that swallows stars.

Galaxy Slash (銀河斬).

Before the blade that cut down an entire myth, the strongest constellation who had ruled the primordial void smiled.

[With this—]

The final chapter of the grand 'Ragnarok' was at last raising its curtain.

[Asgard is eternal.]

---

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression exhaled roughly and withdrew his story.

His vision was hazy. It was probably because he had exerted excessive power.

【Kim Dokja.】

A name he called without thinking. The sound of his own voice calling that name felt unfamiliar.

At some point it had come to resemble the voice of an Outer God.

His ominous face was reflected on the blade of the Black Heavenly Demon Sword stained with story.

「The story of the dead Odin was scattering across the world.」

The fragments of Odin that scattered like pure white starlight soon became part of the 'Stage'. Upon that stage stood another Yoo Joonghyuk blocking his path.

[A Giant Story is being realized!]

Odin had probably already foreseen his own death.

「This was the only method that could kill the 'Wolf That Swallowed God'.」

As the stage of 'Ragnarok' strengthened, an astonishing story power began surging throughout the entire body of Yoo Joonghyuk from the 41st regression.

「He was the great star that hunted the final wolf.」

Through his own death, Odin had passed the [Fate] of 'Ragnarok' to the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression.

Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression watched that sight with indifferent eyes and asked.

【Is the thing you trusted merely the power of that 'stage'?】

As if looking down upon the stage of 'Ragnarok', the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression raised his status.

[The Giant Story 'Ragnarok' is swaying dangerously!]

Certainly the Giant Story of 'Ragnarok' was powerful. But he was an existence who had already seen the ending twice. No story of this world could completely bind him to a 'Stage'. Yet at that moment the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression opened his mouth.

"You—"

The moment he heard that voice, he realized it was not the voice of the '41st regression'.

「Kim Dokja.」

Another Kim Dokja dwelling within the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression was asking him.

"Does this place still look like 'Ragnarok' to you?"

Clad in Odin's starlight, the coat that Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st regression was wearing shone pure white and took on a white hue.

For a moment, Yoo Joonghyuk from the 1,865th regression looked down at his own pitch black coat.

「Only then did Yoo Joonghyuk realize the meaning of this battlefield.」

This was a confrontation between Yoo Joonghyuk and Yoo Joonghyuk.

Two Yoo Joonghyuks wearing coats of different colors faced each other.

One on the ground, and the other in the sky. The moment he realized that he himself was within that landscape, Yoo Joonghyuk of the 1,865th regression recalled a very old story.

「Once, he had stood in their place.」

In the days when he firmly believed himself to be the Yoo Joonghyuk of the 3rd regression. He had stood there together with Kim Dokja. Standing there, he had faced a certain Outer God that seemed absolutely impossible to defeat.

'So this is how you felt, you bastard.'

In the sky, where that Outer God had once stood, he now stood alone.

[The Great Disaster 'Wolf That Swallowed God' is roaring.]

Perhaps it was only at that moment that Yoo Joonghyuk understood another version of himself from a very long time ago. The moment understanding was established, accompanied by the sound of an old page turning, the landscape of the surrounding area began to ripple.

[The 'Stage' is resonating.]

The distant sound of water from the Tongtian River covered the battlefield of 'Ragnarok'.

[A new Story has been born.]

The two Yoo Joonghyuks pointed spear and sword at each other, and at last an old story began to be reenacted.

[The Story 'Qualification of the Protagonist' has begun its storytelling.]

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1061 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (9)

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「Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> could become an enemy.」

First making that assumption was something that happened before obtaining a Myth-grade status.

「What if, in the worst case scenario, Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> tries to destroy this worldline?」

Since Han Sooyoung also visited this worldline for such a purpose, it was not an impossible assumption. But back then, even if I made such an assumption, no way to deal with Yoo Joonghyuk came to mind. It was even more so after accumulating stories and rising to the status of 'Myth-grade'.

Literally a sky beyond the sky. Yoo Joonghyuk, who saw two conclusions, was an enemy I could not deal with no matter what I did right now.

「Perhaps Yoo Joonghyuk of the 41st round also felt a despair similar to mine.」

Was the sentiment of the stars facing the 'Final Wall' right before their eyes like this? The Yoo Joonghyuk we are facing right now was an existence that filled the surface of that distant wall and completed two 'conclusions'.

「He cannot be defeated through ordinary methods.」

So what I prepared was 'stage transformation'.

「However, in order to complete this stage, several conditions were necessary.」

This scenario is the stage of 'Ragnarok'. Since he descended as the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', our side also needed preparation fitting for it.

「Odin's stories scattered across the world were strengthening the 'stage' of Ragnarok.」

The original myth of Ragnarok begins with 'All-Father' Odin being killed by the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' Fenrir. Therefore, to deal with Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> summoned as the proxy of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', Odin's death was essential.

「The son of an old myth shall execute revenge.」

Executing revenge for Odin who died in the original myth is Vidar, the 'Concluder of War'. But in this round, Vidar the 'Concluder of War' was already dead. Thus, the one who could act as his proxy was 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk who killed him and took his story.

Rumbleeee!

The blessing of the 'Concluder of War' was granted to 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body, and his body sparkled radiantly with the story of 'Ragnarok'.

Rumbleeee!

A baptism of thrusts from the Soul Extinguishing Divine Spear rising like flash lightning. 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk floating in the firmament frowned and struck back at the spear strikes.

【Trivial skills.】

Despite the storm of formidable status, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk was unshaken. He even gradually approached this way through the storm of spear strikes.

[The great disaster, 'Wolf That Swallowed a God', directly resists the Probability of 'Ragnarok'!]

As expected. I did not expect to be able to defeat him with just the Giant Story of 'Ragnarok'. Because the opponent is that 'Yoo Joonghyuk' of <Kim Dokja's Company>. To break him, a stronger 'role' was needed. So what was prepared was precisely this second stage.

[Story, 'Inheritor of Eternal Name', wriggles!]

I activated the story inside me and called my brothers.

'Second brother. Third brother.'

Because to fully recreate this stage, the help of the other two Kim Dokjas was necessary.

Tap.

And from beyond the wall, the sound of my brothers responding was heard. The one who reacted first was the second brother.

[Giant Story, 'Season of Light and Darkness', begins its storytelling.]

That was the Giant Story of 'Great War of Saints and Demons' in which <Kim Dokja's Company> participated. In that battlefield, Kim Dokja faced Constellations of Good and Evil, and awakened the Dragon of the Apocalypse.

「【Puppet of the Oldest Dream. You know nothing about 'Kim Dokja'.】」

And there, the 'Two Yoo Joonghyuks' met for the first time.

「That is the hell of eternal immortality.」

That day, Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> was defeated. It could not be helped. Because his enemy was a distant Outer God that could not be dealt with even by dedicating all his history—the 'Secretive Plotter'.

「Yoo Joonghyuk could not fathom the depth of that vast emotion.」

That day, the 'Secretive Plotter' took Kim Dokja and vanished to his residence, and Yoo Joonghyuk fell from the sky like a bird that lost its wings.

「A coat turned to rags. The unconscious Yoo Joonghyuk was falling to the ground.」

However, because there was that day's defeat, there was also subsequent victory.

[Giant Story, 'Liberator of the Forgotten', begins its storytelling!]

The 'Giant Story' that the third brother possessed. On the stage of 'Journey to the West'—above the battlefield of Tongtian River, the two Yoo Joonghyuks clashed once again. However, this time it was the exact opposite position.

「A man in a white coat was looking up at the firmament. Then a man in a black coat met that gaze.」

Before my eyes, that day at Tongtian River was being recreated. To me and 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk, the story accumulated by that day's Kim Dokja and Yoo Joonghyuk dwelt.

「Light and darkness were colliding. And only a single watcher observed all those stories.」

The Dark Heavenly Moon Spear and the Black Heavenly Demon Sword crossed, causing a sharp friction sound. An offense and defense so fast that the black and white coats turned to rags. Countless slashes and thrusts collided, causing a storm of stories.

「This is a history that Yoo Joonghyuk can never reject.」

On that stage, Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> whom I knew was fighting. Desperately swinging his sword.

【You guys cannot win.】

Now in a voice resembling the 'Secretive Plotter', he was speaking.

「【Is a story that failed to reach a proper 'conclusion' a failed story?】」

The two stages created an overlapping effect, bringing about an even stronger synergy. Although it was an evenly matched duel, it felt like the balance of victory was tipping ever so slightly.

「【Do you really think a 'proper conclusion' exists in this world?】」

Every time the story continued, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk staggered noticeably. I looked at Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company>, at his two eyes gradually growing empty.

「This is the most cowardly method to deal with the 'protagonist' of a story.」

He was looking at us, but at the same time he was not looking at us. Perhaps he was currently in the past.

「The story currently making him up was not 'Ways of Survival'.」

Once, he was an existence made up of the story of 'Ways of Survival'. But now it was not so. Currently, the story making up his body was—

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is activated even more strongly!]

The story written by Han Sooyoung, read by Kim Dokja, and lived by him.

「【There is only one difference between you and me.】」

Therefore, he can neither resist this story nor break this stage. Because he endured his remaining life solely through this story. Just as Kim Dokja once did.

「【You were lucky, and I was unlucky.】」

Along with a roaring sound, rays of light burst forth. In the collapsing surroundings, for the first time, one leg of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' buckled. 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk did not miss that open gap in his spear stance. The thrust learned from Master Jaewhan. Imbued into the essence of long refinement.

Soul Extinguishing Divine Spear and Breaking the Sky Sword Style. Spear and sword. Divine strike and slash collided, and a wild wind of stories blew before our eyes. A feast of sword techniques so intense it blinded the eyes and burst the ears. Deflecting the flying slashes, the moment 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk pierced through the pure white light and launched the final thrust—

「The sound of something falling from the sky was heard.」

Victory was right before our eyes. That regressor possessing supreme status was finally falling.

「He was by no means an existence that would collapse so easily.」

In the recreated stage, the soul of the falling Yoo Joonghyuk was vividly felt.

「He simply gave up fighting before this story.」

The brilliant storm of stories settled down, and the surroundings gradually began to clear up. 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk advanced through the dust without hesitation and leveled

his spear.

Soon, when the dust vanished, Yoo Joonghyuk's spear tip was touching precisely the throat of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God'. Collapsed onto the ground, the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' was looking up at the sky where stars had gone out.

「He had an expression as if accepting his own ■■.」

In that vast universe he looked up at endlessly, the star he searched for no longer existed. At the distant emotion welling up, I spoke involuntarily.

"You must not kill him."

I wanted to run over right away and raise him up. I wanted to tell him that this was not your end. But I could not do so. What I had to do was stop the destruction of this worldline and stop 'Snowfield Kim Dokja's conclusion. For that, I had to defeat him here.

"This is... enough."

According to the original myth of 'Ragnarok', the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' must die here. But there was no need to strictly follow that original myth. Because just incapacitating him was sufficient to achieve the goal.

Tzztzz.

It was at that moment that stories wavered from 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' continues its storytelling.]

The will of the Giant Story trying to realize itself.

"Yoo Joonghyuk?"

The stopped spear tip of 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk began to move.

「Thus finally, the end of the 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' approached.」

I hurriedly strengthened [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint]. Fortunately, the timing was not late. The moment [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] activated to the limit was about to seize 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk's body—

"Wait a moment, Yoo Joong—!"

My shout could not continue to the end. In the next moment, along with a feeling as if striking the back of my head hard, something bounced my soul out.

['1st Person Protagonist's Point of View' is deactivated!]

The last thing I saw was the two empty eyes of Yoo Joonghyuk deeply despaired at the story.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' is forcibly deactivated!]

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Yoo Joonghyuk felt Kim Dokja's soul leaving his body. As expected, it seemed this possession skill would not persist if he, the master of the body, strongly rejected it.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' forces your action.]

Yoo Joonghyuk felt the power of the 'Giant Story' dwelling in his right hand. The story of Vidar, the 'Concluder of War' who granted him power, reacted and commanded him.

「Killthe disaster killthe disaster killthe disaster killthe disaster killthe disaster killthe disaster killthe disaster killthe disaster」

If it were an ordinary incarnation, it was a terrible story that would dominate the mind just by listening to it.

'Noisy.'

However, Yoo Joonghyuk calmly stared at that story and muttered.

'If you keep blabbering, I will cut off the arm.'

In an instant, with a tzztzztzz sound, the power of the story forcing Yoo Joonghyuk's right arm weakened.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' is amazed by the proxy's will.]

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' temporarily pauses its storytelling.]

Perhaps the Giant Story realized instinctively. If the incarnation before its eyes truly intended to refuse, it could not truly be realized on this stage.

In the place where the quieted story paused its storytelling, a emaciated disaster was sitting collapsed. Yoo Joonghyuk stared quietly down at that 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk. The moment he looked into his eyes, Yoo Joonghyuk could tell. Only he, as a regressor, could understand those eyes.

Right now he is here, but at the same time he is not here. Perhaps he was having a terrible dream. In the landscape created by the story he lived, he was living through moments flowing like a revolving lantern.

"Is that the history you lived through?"

Through the story shown by Kim Dokja, Yoo Joonghyuk also came to know that day's stories. He came to know well what story they experienced in the 1,864th round and what tragedy they endured.

"Are you going to give up there?"

Yoo Joonghyuk kept silent for a moment, staring at the disaster that looked identical to him. Then, with an expression as if unwilling to admit it, he spoke gritting his teeth.

"You are 'Yoo Joonghyuk'."

Perhaps that was respect toward the regressor who returned to the world of scenarios once again even after seeing the conclusion of a world.

At the name calling him, the disaster slowly raised his head.

【You know nothing.】

"Did you not come to destroy this world?"

【None of your business—】

"Stand up. There are no interlopers now."

Only at the moment he heard those words did 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk raise his head once again. Intense wavering was flowing in his eyes. He too realized late.

Tzztzztzz...

The power of the Giant Story weighing down on him was gradually weakening. Before long, the river water of Tongtian River and the night sky of the Great War of Saints and

Demons vanished. All the stages pressuring Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja's Company> vanished, and only two Yoo Joonghyuks remained in that place.

【...What are you doing?】

"Let me settle the match again."

As if unable to understand those words, Yoo Joonghyuk frowned and spoke.

【The match is already decided.】

Clearly the fight was over, and history repeated itself. One Yoo Joonghyuk lost, and another Yoo Joonghyuk won. Nevertheless, the winning Yoo Joonghyuk did not have a happy expression at all.

"This is the 41st round."

Rather, he had a face as if enduring terrible humiliation. He looked down at the traces of the 'stage' floating around the area—the story fragments of the 1,864th round that allowed him to win—and added:

"It is my 'worldline'."

The moment he heard those words, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk's eyes widened.

[Story, 'Qualifications of a Protagonist', continues its storytelling.]

Only then did Yoo Joonghyuk realize what the Yoo Joonghyuk before his eyes was saying. Right now, the 41st round was speaking. For the conclusion of this round, the history of another worldline was not needed.

Slowly taking a deep breath, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk stood up from his seat.

【You are showing useless pride.】

Now an immense status that could not be forced by anything began to flow out from his entire body once again.

【You will regret it.】

This is Yoo Joonghyuk's final desperate battle that will decide the final chapter of the worldline. Transcendent status flowed from 41st round's entire body.

"I will not regret anything."

A supreme spirit (霸氣) that never backs down even before an enemy that seems impossible to defeat. Therefore this <Star Stream>—

"I am Yoo Joonghyuk."

Calls him the Supreme King (霸王).

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1062 Episode 66. The Wolf That Swallowed a God (10)

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There, Yoo Joonghyuk and Yoo Joonghyuk stood. One had lived through scenarios spanning 1,865 rounds, and the other had lived through scenarios reaching the 41st round. Though the histories they lived through differed, the two pointing spear and sword at each other knew. The existence before their eyes right now was unmistakably the 'Supreme King Yoo Joonghyuk'.

【I will not use stories.】

1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk spoke. At the same time, the aura of stories subsided from his entire body. The stories of <Kim Dokja Company>, the Giant Stories he built himself, and even the Giant Story of 'Ragnarok' calmed down. Standing there was simply the pure Yoo Joonghyuk who endured two conclusions.

"It seems you are the one showing useless pride."

As if matching him, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk also put his stories to rest. However, putting stories to sleep did not mean they were truly not using stories at all.

「The flesh they lived in was itself their story.」

Stories accumulated over long ages soon become part of the soul. Difficult memories, sorrowful memories, every moment of overcoming despair and frustration to stand again

became their very selves, turning into swinging fists and trajectories of sword and spear. Therefore, the two were clashing with all their stories while not actively using them.

The moment rays of light flashed, the two existences vanished from the air at the same time.

Kudududuk!

As spear tip and sword blade met, fierce sparks flew. Strikes containing the pinnacle of martial arts spoken of by Transcendents. At a glance, they were merely cutting and thrusting movements, but within each simple trajectory lay the story of the life they had lived.

Kugugugu!

At the impact, the Dark Heavenly Moon Spear wavered, and the Black Heavenly Demon Sword creaked. 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk narrowed his eyes and spoke.

【I did not know you could reach such a realm in a mere 41st round.】

"You seem weak for someone who lived through 1,865 rounds."

In that moment, the movement of the sword changed. Breaking the Sky Meteor Strike (破天流星決). A cluster of meteors pouring from the firmament to the ground. In response, the secret technique of the Soul Extinguishing Divine Spear was fired from the spear tip. Ten Thousand Stars Falling (萬星墜落). Two martial arts created to kill stars collided, and once again the trajectories of the two men crossed.

First exchange, second exchange, third exchange. In the offensive and defensive exchange in the blink of an eye, the one pushed back first was 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk.

'He is strong.'

Even while suppressing Giant Stories, the 'Great Disaster' before his eyes was a monster. 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk could not know what kind of time 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk had endured to reach that realm. He could only gauge his story through the faintly seen fragments.

「A story of deep regret was carried in every trajectory of the Black Heavenly Demon Sword.」

A regressor lives powered by regret. Yet the Yoo Joonghyuk before his eyes was one who had seen the end of a world twice. Even after seeing the landscape he wished to

reach, why did he shudder in such profound regret?

"Were you not satisfied even after seeing the end of the scenarios?"

Dodging the slashes slicing through the air, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk asked.

"Why were you not content with the story given to you? Did you not already prevent the destruction of the world?"

After a slight pause, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk answered.

【You cannot understand.】

The pouring sword strikes grew fiercer. 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk parried the slashes with all his might and spoke.

"You must have already experienced enough deaths of companions. Don't you know by now? There are things in this world that cannot be undone. Even with our [Regression], we cannot save everything."

【.....】

"If you lived through 1,865 rounds, you should know that fact better than anyone—"

【You, in a mere 41st round, cannot understand anything.】

As two convictions collided, a roaring sound erupted once more.

「Yoo Joonghyuk's goal was to prevent the destruction of this world. To clear all scenarios and liberate Earth from the <Star Stream>.」

Certainly, at one time Yoo Joonghyuk lived through scenarios solely for that purpose. He endured all those years to destroy this 'damned Star Stream'.

"Did you meet the 'Oldest Dream'?"

The Oldest Dream. At those words, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk's expression hardened for the first time.

【I met him.】

41st round Yoo Joonghyuk still did not know much about his sponsor. He only knew that the existence was called the 'Oldest Dream', and that he was regressing through that

existence's power. And now, he had vaguely come to know that his sponsor was deeply related to the existence named 'Kim Dokja'.

"My sponsor—"

Perhaps that was a question the original Yoo Joonghyuk would never have asked.

"What did he look like?"

Even so, just this once, he wanted to hear it. His opponent was the 1,865th round. In the eyes of another self who lived through that distant time, what did his sponsor look like?

【That guy was.】

The moment he uttered those words, there was a story brushing past 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk's retina. 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk read a fragment of that story. He read the pure emptiness contained within that tale, and the complicated heart that no story could unravel.

【Small.】

With that single word, an illusion wavered over 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk's retina. It was the figure of a child disappearing together with a man.

"He was small?"

Without answering, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk brandished his sword again. As if that was all he could tell him.

Shooting Star Slash. 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk's main technique unfolded. Explosive energy so powerful that not even a Myth-grade Constellation could survive. 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk leveled his spear toward the incoming sword aura. A technique that the current him could not properly withstand. Even so, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk did not back down. The sound of dull chains snapping echoed from his entire body.

「Restriction of Life」

This was the 'final imprint' among the 'three story imprints' he possessed.

「He had activated this story imprint only once before. When escaping the Recycling Center and being chased by Nebulae, encountering his master Jaewhan.」

If 'Restriction of Truth' touched his memories and 'Restriction of Emotion' touched his humanity, the final imprint, 'Restriction of Life', was literally a story imprint that staked his life force. Like a moth burning its own life, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk's entire body began to shine like a bright sun.

Tukwang!

His tightly condensed spear aura deflected the flying beams of Shooting Star Slash.

【You bastard.】

Recognizing the identity of the 'story imprint', 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk frowned.

【Do you wish to die?】

"No."

41st round Yoo Joonghyuk answered in a voice devoid of falsehood.

"I intend to survive."

And once again, the two Yoo Joonghyuks clashed. The Black Heavenly Demon Sword spewed fire once more, followed by a sequence of slashes far greater than before.

Shooting Star Slash — Two Consecutive Strikes.

The very technique that defeated Odin poured from 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk's sword.

Shooting Star Slash — Three Consecutive Strikes.

And surprisingly, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk was continuing the fight by dodging or deflecting the Shooting Star Slashes.

「He could feel his life rapidly running out.」

It was truly a desperate life-and-death battle. The pinnacle of martial power an incarnation body could reach. Controlling the martial prowess that reached its absolute limit in an instant, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk continued his thrusts. His entire history exceeded even the trajectories of meteors and surged toward the 1,865th round.

Tzztzztzz!

And for the first time, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk was pushed back a step. A razor-thin match. Every time sword and spear collided, ripples spread across the universe. Before long, both Yoo Joonghyuks were completely absorbed in battle. And ever so slightly, the scale of victory began to tip once more. The one who noticed the omen first was 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk.

"You—"

Stories were flowing from 1,865th round's entire body. No, to be precise, between the two of them—

['Stage Transformation' is activated!]

A new stage was opening. Subsequently, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk spoke in a bewildered voice.

【It is not my will.】

Clearly, neither 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk nor 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk had used stories. Yet between the two, a 'stage' crafted by stories was opening. It was neither the 'Season of Light and Darkness' nor the 'Liberator of the Forgotten'. This was simply their history.

"This is—"

It was the 'history' of the 1,864th round.

「The two existences had already faced each other once before.」

41st round Yoo Joonghyuk glared at the stories drifting chaotically before his eyes.

「Can one become this strong after going through 41 rounds?」

「To be precise, it is merely this much.」

Within the chaotically floating stories was him, and the Yoo Joonghyuk before his eyes. The two men were fighting. 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk opened his mouth as if groaning.

【I have already met you before.】

As if refusing to receive something like stage transformation effects, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk spoke in a resentful voice.

【In my worldline.】

The contents of the story were simple. In that story, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk possessed Kim Dokja and fought against the 1,864th round Yoo Joonghyuk. And he lost. But the reason 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk was shocked was not because of the victory or defeat recorded in that story.

"I see."

A worldline in the far distant future. The stage of the 1,864th round. The fact that the '41st round Yoo Joonghyuk' existed on that stage.

"As expected, was this a fight whose end was predetermined from the beginning?"

41st round Yoo Joonghyuk muttered bitterly.

「The worldline of the 41st round will be destroyed.」

Only after his world is destroyed will other worldlines begin. The 1,864th round and the 1,865th round before his eyes. And the stories of worlds he does not know.

「Only when his world is completely destroyed will all those stories begin.」

Predetermined despair weighed heavily upon his shoulders. All these worlds, all these stories, were urging a single conclusion upon him.

【You did your best.】

Toward such a 41st round, the 1,865th round was speaking.

【Just because you failed does not mean that entire life was wrong.】

That was advice only Yoo Joonghyuk could give to another Yoo Joonghyuk. The problem was that the one listening to that advice was also Yoo Joonghyuk.

"Don't blabber so haughtily when you failed in the end as well."

【...What?】

Hearing those words, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk felt a strange deja vu. Perhaps once before, they had shared a similar conversation.

"I have no intention of listening to the advice of a failure."

With those words, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk took a step forward.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' resumes its storytelling!]

It was then that the 'Giant Story' which held its breath abruptly resumed its storytelling. The stage of 'Ragnarok' and the stage of the '1,864th round' overlapped, offsetting the stage transformation in an instant. Beyond the offset stage, spear and sword crossed.

「Only one 'Yoo Joonghyuk' will survive here.」

Both the 41st round and the 1,865th round knew. This was a battle deciding the end of a story.

Was it coincidence, or was it intention? For a moment, 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk staggered once again. 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk did not miss that opening.

[The influence of Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' grows stronger!]

If he thrust into that opening, he could win. Even so, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk could not thrust his spear. Even while watching the blade falling right before his nose.

While time flowed slowly like a revolving lantern, the two empty eyes of 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk were visible.

「If that existence dies here, what would that bastard say?」

Strangely, at the final moment, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk thought of his companion. The guy once called Cheon Inho, and now called Kim Dokja.

Now 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk's sword was right in front of him. He had to thrust even now. Only then could he kill him.

「And Yoo Joonghyuk made up his mind.」

Beyond the lingering silence, over the blank space that no story could fill, the sound of flesh tearing echoed.

[The first 'stage' of Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' has ended.]

---

With a gasp, when I came to my senses, I was back in my own body. The recoil from [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] being deactivated ached and rang through my head.

What happened? What about Yoo Joonghyuk? That bastard, what on earth did he—

[Have you awakened?]

Turning my head, Mass Production Maker was looking at me. For some reason, his face was full of worry. There was no need to ask why.

[Dawn is coming.]

Beyond the sky where starlight had disappeared, dawn broke. No, strictly speaking, it was not the sun. Pure white stories wavering beyond the horizon. Disasters following him while emitting pure white light were dyeing the battlefield in a white night.

「Master of the Erased Blank — Snow White.」

At last, my brother had arrived at this battlefield.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1063 Episode 67. The World Serpent (1)

【O o o o o o o o】

In the distance, the sorrowful cries of the 'Gods of Other Worlds' could be heard. Not intending to march this way immediately, they halted their movements and repeatedly let out cries toward somewhere.

「They seemed to be waiting for something.」

I didn't know what they were thinking, but for our side, a useful intermission had been created.

Amidst the wavering air of the battlefield, I quickly took stock of the recent situation.

[Exclusive skill, 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' cannot be activated.]

[Reactivating 'Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint' on the target is impossible.]

Was it because the skill was forcibly deactivated? [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] did not activate again on 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk.

「Yoo Joonghyuk is in danger.」

The deactivation of [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] was not by my will, but by 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk's. I recalled the final scene I had witnessed just before the skill deactivated.

「Why did 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk make such a choice?」

Victory was practically assured. The overlapping stage transformation produced brilliant synergy, and 1,865th round Yoo Joonghyuk was sinking deeply into the surging stories like the 'Secretive Plotter' of the past. Yet at the final moment, 41st round Yoo Joonghyuk shook off my help and chose to face him alone.

「Yoo Joonghyuk's presence cannot be felt.」

I hurriedly checked the entry status of the 'Archive of Records'.

[You are currently unable to enter the 'Archive of Records'.]

[The 'Archive of Records' in this area is severely damaged!]

Perhaps the moment the stories of the 1,864th round flooded in, the interior of the 'Archive of Records' suffered massive damage. A situation where neither as a reader nor as a writer could I assist Yoo Joonghyuk.

「Right now, the only existence capable of changing that story was the 'protagonist'.」

Do I have no choice but to trust Yoo Joonghyuk for now? Inhaling softly, I slowly stood up. As if waiting, the surrounding Constellations looked at me.

[It seems Odin did well.]

The one who spoke first was Poseidon, who was fiddling with a broken piece of a recorder.

"Yes."

[How was his end?]

I recalled Odin's final moments. The strongest star of <Asgard> who sacrificed all his stories to become the offering for 'Ragnarok'.

"It was an end fitting of his modifier."

One-Eyed Father Odin. In the end, though I expected him to appear on the stage of 'Ragnarok', actually seeing that landscape firsthand gave a completely different dimension of impression.

「A star that illuminates the beginning of a story while prepared for death.」

Solely to record the stories of <Asgard> into the <Star Stream>, he sacrificed everything he had to become this very 'stage'. Until now, I had seen countless Constellations intoxicated by stories or consumed by them to death, but seeing even a Myth-grade Constellation like Odin unable to escape that yoke gave me a strange feeling.

「How am I any different?」

In the end, all beings live by stories, and die by stories once again. It was the same for Kim Dokja, and for Yoo Joonghyuk. In the end, the ■■ they all desire exists, and every character dies toward that finale. And whether we reach that concluding landscape or not, everything remains as a story.

In doing so, we become part of the <Star Stream> that the 'Oldest Dream' loves.

[Is it my turn to step up now?]

The 'Abyssal Black Flame Dragon', who had remained silent all along, rose to his feet as well. As if waiting, the story of the Dragon of the Apocalypse flowed from his entire body.

[It will be the final war of the <Star Stream>.]

The Handsome Monkey King, sitting cross-legged, opened his eyes as well. Within his pupils, the harmonized stories of multiple Sun Wukongs were churning.

It was then that a commotion was heard outside the inner castle.

"Writer-nim."

Along with Cha Yerin's voice, the tent of the situation room fluttered. Outside the tent, incarnations being urgently transported somewhere were visible. And among those incarnations was a welcome face turned toward this direction.

"Kim Dokja."

Anna Croft, who had been dispatched to the 'Altar of Storms' to assist Yoo Joonghyuk, had finally arrived on the battlefield. She wasn't the only one.

"Kim Anna-ssi."

"It has been a while."

Incarnations of the Japanese side, including Asuka Ren. The powerhouses remaining in the inner castle sensed the emergence of the Outer Gods and gathered toward the situation room one by one.

"It seems it will finally begin."

Anna Croft spoke in a tense voice. Her 'Great Demon's Eye' emitting [Future Sight] shone with bright light.

"Dionysus's side also said they will join soon."

Fortunately, the surviving Constellations also seemed to have decided to take our side. Since the situation was dire enough that we'd take even little Yoo Joonghyuk's hand, any help was deeply appreciated.

I slowly examined the forces we currently had. What caught my eye first were the 'Kings'.

Abyssal Black Flame Dragon.

Mass Production Maker.

Handsome Monkey King.

And behind them was a Myth-grade Constellation of Olympus clutching a broken trident.

Poseidon.

Just as Odin had resolved, his gaze showed he too foresaw the final battle here. Once an enemy, and a Constellation treated as a Myth-grade 'power-scaling benchmark' in the main story, his help would nonetheless be of immense aid.

Just as I was about to ask Poseidon if there were any other Myth-grade Constellations—an unknown sense of incongruity struck me. Looking around calmly at the companions again, I asked the 'Mass Production Maker'.

"Where is Heewon-ssi?"

It was then that a roaring boom sounded in the distance. I hurriedly examined the battlefield scenery on the screen floating in front of 'Mass Production Maker'.

[A 'Great Disaster' reveals its status!]

A system message ringing in my ears. But there were no particular signs of disturbance on this battlefield. In other words, the 'Great Disaster' indicated by the 'system message' was not present on this 'battlefield'.

「All the Outer Gods on the battlefield were staring in a single direction in unison.」

I could tell instinctively. In the direction they were looking, the most important battle of this battlefield was currently taking place. Watching that scenery together, the 'Mass Production Maker' spoke.

[She left alone to stop the 'Great Disaster'.]

"Alone? Why—"

[With the battle against 'Snow White' ahead, we could not afford to deplete our forces any further.]

I bit my lower lip hard. No matter how strong Jung Heewon had become, and even if Uriel of the 1,864th round was with her, Jung Heewon alone could not stop a Great Disaster.

In the distant sky, with a kudududuk sound, cracks began to form. A sound as if something massive from the outside of this world was constricting the entire outer wall.

Kwakwakwakwa!

As the landscape of the sky shattered, the shadow of a gigantic serpent was revealed beyond the scenery. I recognized immediately what that serpent was. It was the second 'Great Disaster' of this 'Ragnarok'.

"The World Serpent."

There was no doubt. The 'Great Disaster' Jung Heewon went to stop was that 'World Serpent'.

「Thus shall the 'Serpent Who Remembers the End and Beginning of the World' proclaim the destruction of the Nine Worlds.」

Along with the Giant Story echoing through the firmament, the status of the World Serpent was clearly felt even from afar. Biting my lip tightly, I glared at that scenery.

「The 'Wolf That Swallowed a God' was Yoo Joonghyuk of <Kim Dokja Company>.」

Then who was the 'World Serpent' descended over there right now?

Just as I was about to say that we had to go help Jung Heewon right this second, movements were detected on this battlefield as well.

[They are moving.]

Along with the 'Mass Production Maker's' warning, the ground heaved violently.

Thump.

One step, and another step.

Thump.

The sound of Outer Gods approaching was heard. Countless disasters following Snow White. And—

「At their center was a loyal retainer following 'Snow White'.」

It felt as if time came to a standstill. Abyssal Black Flame Dragon, Mass Production Maker, and even the Myth-grade Constellation Poseidon stiffened in their expressions.

【Ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah ah】

Pain, sorrow, despair, frustration, discouragement—a terrible cry was echoing, as if gathering all the negative emotions of the <Star Stream> and vomiting them out.

[A new 'Great Disaster' reveals its status!]

I knew who the owner of this cry was. Because upon entering 'Ragnarok', I had already encountered that existence.

[Emperor.]

With the Handsome Monkey King's gritted voice, dazzling sparks began to strike across the surrounding sky. Mass Production Maker spoke with a wry smile.

[It seems that existence took on the role of a 'Great Disaster' as well.]

The anomalous form of Nebula <Emperor>.

Fuxi (伏羲).

Shennong (神農).

Nüwa (女媧).

Yellow Emperor (黃帝).

Zhuanxu (顓頊).

As many as five Myth-grade Constellations were howling, fused into a single mass. Unlike when we encountered them in space before, their spinning heads were attached to the torso of a giant dog.

[Great Disaster, 'Watchdog Guarding the Path of the End' lets out a long howl!]

Watchdog Guarding the Path of the End — Garmr.

「At last, the 'Watchdog Guarding the Path of the End' opened the gates of hell.」

Along with the stories blanketing the battlefield, the stars of the inner castle stirred violently. They were all stars who had ascended from the hall alongside the 'Kings'.

[H-Hyaaaaaah!]

[Insane—are they telling us to fight that kind of monster?]

[I-I shouldn't have come after all.]

[Is this place to become the graveyard of stars...]

When the anomalous form of Emperor alone was overwhelming to handle, that anomaly had transformed into a disaster of 'Ragnarok'. All the stars here knew. Even if all remaining Constellations joined forces, defeating that monster was impossible.

Yet even knowing that fact, there were those who did not give up until the end.

"Let us do our best."

Standing at the center of the incarnations, Kim Anna-ssi spoke, looking around with a calm expression.

"We knew from the beginning who our enemy would be, did we not?"

When she who possessed [Future Sight] said so, the light of hope returned to the eyes of the trembling incarnations. Within them lay stories as well. The stories of incarnations striving to realize their own tales even amidst terrible terror. Watching them, the story within me wriggled vigorously as well.

[Story, 'Successor of the Eternal Name' wishes to realize itself!]

Judging from the fact that he sent the watchdog forward first, my brother seemingly had no intention of entering the battlefield immediately. If so, I still had a choice.

「Although [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint] did not work on Yoo Joonghyuk, it might be different with Jung Heewon.」

However, if I leave this place now, could the remaining Constellations hold out against that Great Disaster?

[Kim Dokja.]

Standing beside me before I knew it, Mass Production Maker asked with a faint smile.

[Do you still dream of 'a conclusion that protects everything you loved'?]

A conclusion that protects everything loved. That was right. Kim Dokja had continuously run toward that conclusion, and in return, failed to protect himself in the end.

"I..."

Watching the approaching horde of Outer Gods, I imagined the conclusion of this world gradually becoming clearer.

"I simply wish for the people who have loved that story to become happy."

As I slowly drew in a breath, the story within me began its storytelling.

「And Kim Dokja made his choice.」

---

Jung Heewon ran through the ruins of the battlefield.

「Her condition was at its absolute best. She feared no enemy whatsoever.」

Running through the rapidly receding landscape, Jung Heewon recalled her last conversation with Kim Dokja. Kim Dokja had said: if something happens, hit him hard to wake him up.

'I couldn't fulfill that request. Sorry.'

When the Great Disaster 'World Serpent' appeared, she did not wake the sleeping Kim Dokja.

「Perhaps it was because it was the first time she had seen him sleep so soundly.」

Though only for a moment, the face of Kim Dokja dreaming was peaceful. Even at the center of this terrible battlefield, he alone looked like someone having a happy dream.

[Someone must stop the 'World Serpent'.]

Jung Heewon wondered about the landscape of the dream he was having.

[We just need to buy time until Kim Dokja wakes up.]

What kind of beings were in that dream? Would that pitch-black man or the companions who followed him appear?

[Buying time in words, but it basically means going to die.]

What kind of adventures were there? What kinds of stories was he living through with people there?

「Would she be in that dream as well?」

Jung Heewon watched the sleeping Kim Dokja for a long time. Even if it was just a brief sweet slumber, Jung Heewon wished for Kim Dokja to remain in that dream just a little longer.

"I will go."

Instead of waking the sleeping Kim Dokja, she quietly stood up.

"I will deal with the World Serpent."

It wasn't merely stubborn pride.

[Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' nods her head.]

Moreover, right now she was not alone. Her sponsor from another worldline. Uriel.

[Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' tells you to trust only her.]

All throughout running toward the World Serpent, Uriel constantly spoke to her.

[Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' admires your growth rate!]

[Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' says no Transcendent could wield a sword like you!]

A star sparkling with boundlessly beautiful light. If there were only Constellations like this in the sky, she felt she might even become friends with beings called Constellations.

[Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' says she is glad to fight together again!]

Jung Heewon knew that the 'Jung Heewon' spoken of by that archangel was not herself. The 1,864th round. Jung Heewon had also seen the history of that worldline.

「The self of that world had already seen the end of all these scenarios alongside companions.」

In that worldline, she was there, and the pitch-black man—Yoo Joonghyuk—was there. And 'Kim Dokja' was there. In that story she knew nothing about, Kim Dokja laughed and cried with them, fought, won, and created stories.

When thinking about that fact, Jung Heewon often found herself engulfed in a confused feeling.

「Who is the 'Jung Heewon' that Kim Dokja remembers?」

Jung Heewon knew that the sleeping Kim Dokja was connected to that world. So even if 'Jung Heewon' appeared in his dream, perhaps that 'Jung Heewon' might not be herself.

'Even so, it is fine.'

Truly, she thought it was completely fine. If solely by that he could have a happy dream —

[Your '■■' is approaching!]

And if by doing so she could be involved in his story even a little.

「The receding scenery began to slow down.」

Jung Heewon slowly came to a halt. Inhaling a breath and looking up at the sky, the Great Disaster she was looking for was coiled there.

「There, the 'World Serpent' was present.」

A monster capable of wrapping around an entire planet and crushing it. A cosmic-scale Great Disaster, the serpent leading the end of 'Ragnarok'. Even though she could not even perceive the entirety of that disaster, Jung Heewon realized.

「It was an enemy she could not contend with.」

A sensation just as dizzying as when facing the anomalous form of Emperor beside 'Snow White'. Even so, she neither feared nor backed down.

Oooooooo!

The firmament distorted as the 'World Serpent' let out a cry. A howl that seemed somehow sorrowful rather than threatening.

[Great Disaster, 'Serpent Who Remembers the End and Beginning of the World' warns you.]

Strangely, the serpent didn't even seem to show hostility toward her. But this was a battle established regardless of malice. For one was a disaster born to destroy the world, and the other was a human of a world that would be destroyed if she did not stop it.

Kugugugugu.

As if warning that further approach would not be forgiven, two gigantic pupils rose in the distant firmament. Jung Heewon gripped her sword. Drawing in a deep breath, all sword paths of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] gathered at the tips of her fingers.

"I don't lose to monsters."

No matter how much the opponent was a 'disaster', as long as that existence was a 'monster', she would not be defeated.

[Exclusive attribute, 'Judge of Destruction' is activated!]

The strongest judge attribute—'Judge of Destruction' finally radiated light against the Great Disaster. Activating [Red Phoenix Shunpo], Jung Heewon closed the distance in an instant and advanced toward the 'World Serpent'.

Just as she was about to plunge a single strike of Breaking the Sky Sword path into that colossal hide—

【...Heewon unnie?】

Beyond the shadow of the World Serpent, someone called her.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1064 Episode 67. The World Serpent (2)

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...Unnie?

At the voice faintly heard, Jung Heewon frowned.

「Is it an illusion? I definitely heard something like a girl's voice just now.」

Moreover, that voice was something she had heard before. While the senses of a Transcendent differentiated time into extreme fractions, Jung Heewon gripped her sword even tighter. As expected, she must have misheard. Above all, there was no way this 'Great Disaster' could speak.

Kagagagak!

Her 'Mikazuki Munechika' struck the hide of the World Serpent and bounced straight off. Formidable recoil slammed into her grip. Jung Heewon frowned slightly.

'Is this not enough?'

Perhaps it was only natural. According to myth, the 'World Serpent' was an entity capable of crushing the entire space-time of this world.

'Once more.'

Jung Heewon concentrated the stories throughout her entire body. The history she had built upright was dwelling in her sword. Running atop the serpent's body, Jung Heewon slashed her sword. Cutting again and again, she ran across the abnormally gigantic 'World Serpent'.

Oooooooo!

As if such sword strikes were nowhere near enough, the body of the 'World Serpent' vibrated violently. The sword blade shook precariously as if about to snap at any second. The more it did, the tighter Jung Heewon gripped the hilt.

[Item, 'Mikazuki Munechika' resonates with you!]

Her sword was an A-grade item obtained from the Theater Dungeon in the early stages of the scenarios. It was a replica of a Star Relic.

「"Why do you insist on such an old sword? It's not even genuine in the first place."」

Those who saw her sword used to ask that.

「"I'd rather forge you a new sword."」

There were blacksmiths who offered to make her a new sword.

「"It is a sword that can no longer be used. Must you insist on using this sword?"」

However, she had never once changed her sword until now.

「"Just repair it somehow. This is enough for me."」

When roaming the scenarios, when walking through the Fear Realm, and when traveling through the New Murim District—she was always together with this sword.

「While holding and swinging this sword, she felt as if she was protecting Kim Dokja.」

A sword that had broken several times while coming all the way here.

「Even if far away, even if unable to see in the end, even if this conviction cannot be completed.」

Stories were condensing at the tip of Jung Heewon's sword.

「Until the moment she drew her last breath, she would not let go of this sword from her hand.」

Holding dazzling rays of light, the sword sliced through the serpent's hide following her will.

Formless Sword Qi (無形劍氣).

Jung Heewon's specialty that elevated her to a new Transcendent realm. A baptism of invisible sword qi began to lacerate the World Serpent.

Tzztzztzz!

And for the first time, a crack appeared in the hide of the 'World Serpent'. Jung Heewon did not miss that gap and continued her sword strikes.

Intent-Formed Sword (意形劍).

The Transcendent realm capable of finally severing even one's own [Fate].

「Incarnation Jung Heewon shall kill the existence she most wanted to protect.」

Her sword stance, tempered to sever that [Fate], transformed into twelve translucent formless swords. The supreme realm called 'Telekinetic Sword Control' by martial artists was at last realized within the scenario.

Obeying her will, the twelve formless swords struck a single concentrated point on the World Serpent. One blade, two blades, three blades. Finally, at the spot struck by all twelve formless swords, the trajectory of the Intent-Formed Sword was added.

Pushushushut!

And at last, the hide of the 'World Serpent' was sliced off. Stories reminiscent of thick poisonous mist burst like fireworks. Jung Heewon held her breath and retreated. Yet she could not control even the poisonous mist seeping into her skin.

[The protection of Constellation, 'Eight-Headed Lord' is with you!]

Just in time, the story of Yamata no Orochi she possessed activated. As Orochi's story repelled the encroaching poisonous fog, her breathing became much easier.

'I can do this.'

No matter how great a disaster, in the end, if she cut and cut again, it would eventually die. Furthermore, she had already killed a 'World Serpent' in the 'Hall'. Even though what she killed was not the genuine 'World Serpent', but 'Yamata no Orochi' who had descended as a degraded version.

[The protection of stories dwells within you!]

Jung Heewon raised her Formless Sword Qi once more and cut into the World Serpent.

Tzztzztzz.

Unable to withstand her stories, 'Mikazuki Munechika' let out a precarious sword ring.

「"You've been using this until now?"」

Kim Dokja, whom she met again after so long, looked at her sword and fell into deep silence for a while. He peered into that blade for a long time. Just from him gazing at that sword, Jung Heewon felt as if he recognized her history. As if he understood how she had fought, and for what purpose she had come all the way here.

「"Thank you, Heewon-ssi."」

Kim Dokja dripped a few drops of his own story onto her sword. Then, her sword, which had been enhanced with D-Coins, mixed with Kim Dokja's story and underwent repeated evolution.

[Item, 'Mikazuki Munechika' transcends its own limits!]

Her sword, born as a replica. That sword, reinforced once again by Kim Dokja's story, exceeded its limits to realize her story.

「"Do you know how large a trajectory a human must draw to cut down the sky?"」

Once, her master, the Breaking the Sky Sword Saint, had asked such a question.

「"I have no idea."」

It was too difficult a question for Jung Heewon. Cutting the sky. In the first place, humans didn't even know from where to where the sky extended. That was why Jung Heewon's answer was simple.

「"Wouldn't it work if I just cut as long an area as possible?"」

That answer was certainly not what her master wanted. Even so, she had walked the path of the sword faithful to that answer until now.

「To humans, the sky is the size of the universe they can perceive.」

Even if she could not cut down all the sky, what if she drew a trajectory to slaughter all of the sky visible to her eyes?

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship (破天劍道). Secret Technique (秘傳奧義). Breaking the Sky Sword Lightning began to grow from her deep blue sword tip. The sword lightning that grew and grew soon exceeded one hundred meters, then two hundred meters. A sword aura easily surpassing several hundred meters. As if to sever the entire horizon, Jung Heewon lifted that heavy history. And—

Single Sword Cleaving the Sky (一劍劈天). She brought down her sword.

Kwakwakwakwa!

Along with a terrifying detonation, stories of the disaster sprayed in all directions. Looking at the haze of stories, Jung Heewon believed that this time she had landed a proper blow.

And in that instant, Jung Heewon vaguely sensed the entirety of the 'World Serpent' extending beyond this planet.

「A single cosmic entity was present there.」

With a stomach-churning shock, Jung Heewon staggered backward.

「For that serpent encircled the world and bit its own tail once again.」

A size more than enough to fully wrap around an entire planet. Exactly how massive that was, Jung Heewon had not been able to properly gauge until now. Only after slicing down all the surrounding sky could Jung Heewon vaguely perceive the scale of this disaster. A serpent embracing this world in its coils.

Was it an illusion? The disaster she glimpsed was a form closer to a dragon rather than a serpent.

「Could that be called a 'monster'?」

She had killed countless monsters until now, but she had never faced such an existence before.

It was then that a strange sensation brushed down her spine.

[Exclusive skill, 'Hour of Judgment' is pending activation.]

'Hour of Judgment' was still not activating. Why? She had clearly activated her exclusive attribute earlier. Jung Heewon activated the skill again.

[Exclusive skill, 'Hour of Judgment' is activated!]

However, the skill was not immediately activated. A belated memory surfaced.

「Her 'Hour of Judgment' activates only when at least one Constellation shares the Probability.」

She had fought relying solely on Transcendent abilities for so long that she had forgotten the activation condition of this skill. To make matters worse, with the Constellations in the channel all dead, she hadn't had the chance to use this skill for quite a while.

If Kim Dokja were here, he would have exercised the authority of 'Acting Constellation' to support her, but Kim Dokja was still in a deep sleep. Fortunately, she had a star that could assist the activation of this skill right now.

"Demon-like Judge of Fire!"

Uriel of the 1,864th round.

[Constellation, 'Demon-like Judge of Fire' is greatly agitated.]

Yet why? Instead of agreeing to the activation of [Hour of Judgment], Uriel was staring up into the air as if dazed.

"Uriel?"

Was she overwhelmed by the size of the World Serpent? The archangel gave no answer to her call.

It was then that a voice was heard once again from beyond the distant firmament.

【Heewon unnie... you're Heewon unnie, right?】

A girl's voice that had no reason to be heard in a place like this. Thinking it might be the sophisticated bewitchment of an Outer God, Jung Heewon shook her head.

【See, I told you it's Heewon unnie!】

【It's really Heewon noona?】

Subsequently, a boy's voice was heard as well. Jung Heewon could not understand. Why on earth were the voices of a boy and a girl coming from inside this terrible World Serpent?

【Did noona also cross over to this world?】

【I think so? I can feel Uriel unnie too.】

Listening to the chattering voices of the two, Jung Heewon felt dizzy. What confused her even more was the deep warmth contained in their voices.

【Heewon unnie!】

The voice of someone deeply cherishing another.

【Please answer! It's unnie, right?】

Jung Heewon stiffened her expression and replied in a harsh voice.

"I don't know who you are."

【What are you talking about? Unnie, didn't you cross over to this worldline? When we parted at the portal back then—】

Only then did the pieces of the puzzle come together in her head.

"I am not the Jung Heewon you are looking for."

Jung Heewon gripped her hilt and spoke.

"I am."

It didn't matter even if the archangel didn't help. She didn't know who they were, but what she had to do was clear.

"The Mad Sword Emperor who will kill you."

She swung her sword. At the Formless Sword Qi she unleashed, the sound of the 'World Serpent's' hide peeling off was heard. Along with the sensation of the World Serpent's

massive body writhing, true words were heard from atop the serpent.

【She's right. She's not the Heewon noona we know.】

At the same time, the movement of the 'World Serpent' began to change. As if stopping it, the girl's voice was heard.

【Lee Gilyoung, don't. That unnie is Heewon unnie too.】

【What are you talking about? We have to do this.】

Jung Heewon reflexively retreated several steps.

【You saw it too. How the end of this world turns out. This is the only way to reach the conclusion.】

Unusual stories were flowing from the World Serpent's entire body.

【Chimera Dragon.】

And in the next moment, Jung Heewon collapsed on the spot feeling a headache as if her skull was splitting.

「The World Serpent was crying.」

It was vomiting out a profoundly deep cry containing the stories they had lived through.

「A distant story that had seen two 'ends' was present there.」

The story of those who fought solely to reclaim a single existence. Under the overwhelming pressure of stories flooding in as a whole, Jung Heewon felt as if her mind would shatter.

「"Dokja ahjussi!"」

「"Dokja hyung!"」

The universe they had fought through to reclaim one person. That universe seemed to be speaking to her.

「This is not a 'stage' someone like you can interfere with.」

Noticing her condition, the boy spoke.

【Noona, just stay still. If you faint for a little while, everything will be over.】

Clutching her bursting heart, Jung Heewon resisted.

"Cut the... bullshit."

The history before her eyes was forcefully crushing her. As if the scenarios she experienced were nothing. As if only the story they lived was the sole existence in all this universe.

'I too—'

Jung Heewon wanted to say it. She understood what kind of tragedy they had experienced. But—

With a crushing sound, unable to bear the pressure, one of her knees broke. Amidst her crumbling vision, Jung Heewon looked up at the World Serpent.

She wanted to reach them. She wanted to prove it. That she was just as desperate as they were. That her desire to protect someone fell short to no one.

[Story, 'Regret, Ruin, Obsession' continues its storytelling.]

Yet she possessed no story to slay such a mythical existence, nor a stage to borrow. All she possessed was a single line of history lived relying solely on a single sword.

「If only I had another history as well.」

She was envious. Envious of the history of other worldlines, and envious of the tragedies they had experienced.

'Even if just once.'

She also wanted to reach that story. She wanted to surpass that world blanketed in stories.

「At that moment, her history began to move.」

A breeze blew in from somewhere.

「With a mere single sentence.」

Her collapsed vision began to rise again. Jung Heewon realized that someone was supporting her.

"Yoosung-ah, Gilyoung-ah."

At first, she wondered if it was Kim Dokja. But he was not Kim Dokja.

"Heewon-ssi is not someone who should be treated like that by you two."

A gentle and firm voice. A voice she also knew. Tall stature and strong muscles. The man who stood her back up on her feet stepped in front of her and spoke.

"Do not kneel. Even if you are not the 'Heewon-ssi' I know—"

A back reminiscent of a sturdy shield.

"You too are 'Jung Heewon', are you not?"

Slowly turning his head, the man looked at her. It was a face she knew.

"This is the second time seeing you in person."

Looking at her with somewhat sorrowful eyes, a story vast as a great mountain flowed from the man's entire body.

「He was the shield who protected Kim Dokja closer than anyone else.」

As if introducing himself to someone he was meeting for the first time, the man looked forward again and spoke.

"Former member of <Kim Dokja Company>. Special Monster Warfare Command—Colonel..."

He was about to say his name, but closed his mouth as if swallowing something deep. Subsequently, silver armor covered the man's entire body. Covered in radiant armor, the man stood by her side looking up at the disaster.

"From now on, we shall commence the subjugation of the 'World Serpent'."

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1065 Episode 67. The World Serpent (3)

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Jung Heewon stared blankly at the man's side profile.

"You are—"

Having possessed the flesh of the 1,864th round in the world of the 'Third Kim Dokja', Jung Heewon had met him before.

「His name was 'Lee Hyunsung'. The 'Lee Hyunsung of the 1,864th round'.」

There were things she remembered vividly. Things like the somewhat burdensome goodwill and the warm gaze. But the emotion felt from him right now was not the warmth of back then.

「The man standing by her side right now stood here solely to protect a single person.」

From a person who has built an upright history, their sincerity is vividly felt even without words. This man also belonged to that kind.

"I roughly heard the story from Dokja-ssi."

"Dokja-ssi?"

Only upon seeing Lee Hyunsung nodding faintly did Jung Heewon realize that he had come here under Kim Dokja's secret order. Kim Dokja probably knew things would turn out like this.

"Why did he send you? You're not very strong."

"Pardon?"

"I saw everything back then. You passed out limp after using just a bit of strength."

Jung Heewon had already seen Lee Hyunsung fight in the world of the 'Third Kim Dokja'. In truth, he had been beaten up by ordinary men in suits there and lost consciousness.

"That was... that world was a place where I couldn't exert my strength."

Lee Hyunsung abruptly coughed dryly and pointed at his forearm. His forearm, glowing silver, certainly looked thicker than back then. Glaring intently at those muscles, Jung Heewon spoke.

"Aren't those balloon muscles?"

"Pardon? No, they aren't! From now on, I will prove—"

"In this world, such bulky muscles aren't needed. Lean muscles are far more advantageous. It's also more convenient to utilize stories or skills. And simple differences in strength can be resolved in many other ways."

Every time Jung Heewon said a word, Lee Hyunsung's neck retracted like a turtle's.

"Everything Heewon-ssi said is correct, but even so—"

"I'm grateful you came to help, but just stay back. You'll only get in the way."

"No, wait..."

The moment the flustered Lee Hyunsung tried to stop Jung Heewon as she stepped forward, a distant true voice resonated from the head of the 'World Serpent'.

【Hyunsungie hyung?】

Jung Heewon and Lee Hyunsung raised their heads at the same time.

【It's Hyunsungie hyung, right!】

【Hyunsung ahjussi!】

Voices that seemed to hold the emotion called yearning deep in the mouth, rolling it on the tip of the tongue over and over again. Just by hearing those voices, Jung Heewon could realize what kind of meaning this man held to their owners.

Lee Hyunsung drew in a deep breath along with a low sigh, then slowly blinked his eyes. Accompanied by a pitch-black glint in his eyes, a sound like iron forged in deep darkness came from his voice.

【Yes, it is me.】

Startled, Jung Heewon looked back at him. The man's expression, which had felt purely naive until just now, had vanished somewhere, replaced by the face of an Outer God who had weathered a long tragedy.

【Please step back. I will handle those children.】

The overwhelming status radiating from his entire body proved the years he had lived and his martial prowess. Even so, Jung Heewon did not back down.

"This isn't a stage for you to step forward."

Rather, that appearance of his, and the joy dwelling in those voices, stirred opposition within her.

【No, this is a stage I must take responsibility for.】

"What are you?"

【The person responsible for all these tragedies.】

The emotion contained in that grave voice was undoubtedly true. But truth could not always persuade everyone.

"Do you think you're any different from that disaster?"

At Jung Heewon's sharp voice, Lee Hyunsung looked back at her once more.

"What do you know about this world's stories?"

Jung Heewon knew she shouldn't say that. She too was feeling the poignant stories emanating from the man before her eyes. She could also gauge to some degree how

terrible a life he had endured to reach this place.

"Without even knowing what kind of history I lived here, or what kind of life I lived."

Yet even so, she could not help but speak like that. Perhaps it was because she was frustrated. Because in the most important scenario, facing an insurmountable obstacle that could not possibly be overcome with her power made her so immensely frustrated.

"Without even knowing properly what happened, doing whatever you want—"

【Yes, I do not know.】

Lee Hyunsung nodded obediently.

【Because I do not know, I came here wanting to understand even a little.】

He advanced forward like a great mountain. With momentum that seemed unyielding to anything, he stood right before the World Serpent.

【Step down, children. I do not wish to fight.】

Before his ringing true voice, the disaster fell silent for a moment. A feeling as if the air was churning heavily. Soon, an answer returned from the top of the World Serpent.

【Why are you trying to stop us?】

A boy's voice that sounded somewhat wronged.

【Hyung knows too, doesn't he? This worldline was originally fated to perish. This place is—】

The 41st round was a world whose outcome was already determined. Words she had heard several times from various people already. The moment Jung Heewon bit her lower lip hard and was about to say something.

【That is not important.】

With a somewhat surprised expression, Jung Heewon looked at Lee Hyunsung.

【Dokja-ssi asked me, so I merely follow his wish. Therefore, this time, you two must give up.】

At his calm warning, the body of the 'World Serpent' trembled faintly. A vibration containing deep sorrow. As if measuring Lee Hyunsung's sincerity, the disaster silently gazed down at him from a dizzying height, then asked back.

【And if we don't give up?】

Lee Hyunsung silently raised both hands. Jung Heewon was purely astonished by that action. He had merely raised his hands, yet there was a force as if an entire mountain range were moving.

【Ah...】

Did she realize the man was serious? The girl groaned as if sighing. Subsequently, the boy sharply asked back.

【Aren't you underestimating us too much?】

The colossal body of the World Serpent vibrated once more. Beyond that faint tremor, the boy's agitated voice was heard.

【No matter how strong hyung is, do you think you can stop us alone?】

At first, she thought the color of the sky had reversed. The pitch-black sky turning deep bluish-green. But looking closely, it was not merely the sky being colored.

「The sky was melting entirely.」

Would it look like that if a story of poison were condensed to its limit? The pitch-black night sky was melting and flowing down from the poison. Soon, the speed at which the sky melted gradually accelerated. Jung Heewon instinctively perceived it. That poison could not be withstood.

A wave of poison on a different dimension from the poisonous fog Yamata no Orochi had used poured over their heads, melting the world. In an instant, all sorts of simulations ran through her mind.

「What if I use Intent-Formed Sword?」

「What if I counter with Breaking the Sky Meteor Strike?」

「What if I cleave the sky once more with [Single Sword Cleaving the Sky]?」

Yet no matter what she did, it didn't seem possible to cut through that tidal wave of poison surging down after melting the entire firmament.

【Lee Gilyoung! Don't!】

The girl's breathless cry. But the tidal wave of poison had already surged to several tens of meters above. Finally, the moment the resolved Jung Heewon gripped her sword hilt, Lee Hyunsung quietly held her back with his right hand. And without any change in expression, he serenely spread his left palm toward the firmament.

「Wall of Steel.」

A translucent curtain of steel manifested around him and her. Jung Heewon was flustered. Normally, she would have shouted that this was not an attack that could be blocked by such a barrier. But the moment she confirmed the barrier's durability, Jung Heewon was startled out of her wits.

「Jung Heewon had never seen a story metal of such immense hardness.」

Subsequently, the tidal wave of poison poured over their heads. Yet even the poison that melted the sky could not melt the man's steel wall. A story that inspired overwhelming awe, making one feel as if nothing in this world could break the protective wall created by this man.

Just how much history did this man endure to obtain this story?

「"Excuse me for a moment."」

A wall where faint warmth lingered. What she could read was merely the remnants of the story dimly left on this wall. Standing tall atop those remnants, the man answered toward the firmament.

【It seems it is not me, but you who are underestimating.】

As the movement of the poison pouring from midair grew sluggish, Lee Hyunsung dispelled the barrier while simultaneously clapping his hands loudly. A massive gale was generated by the clap, completely scattering all the remaining poisonous fog in the area. Then, a voice was heard from above once again.

【We went easy on you this time! No matter if you're hyung, if you interfere any further —】

Instead of listening to those words, Lee Hyunsung took a stride forward and spoke.

【Stand down.】

With that, both of Lee Hyunsung's hands made contact with the outer hide of the World Serpent. In ordinary circumstances, just because both hands touched it didn't mean anything could be done. For the 'World Serpent' was large enough to wrap around an entire planet. But the one who grasped that serpent in his hands this time was none other than 'Lee Hyunsung'. He was the Steel Sword Emperor, the incarnation of the 'Master of Steel'. The sturdiest shield of <Kim Dokja Company>. And this was the first 'stigma' he had ever learned—

「Great Mountain Push.」

Noticing Lee Hyunsung's intention, the boy shouted from midair.

【No matter how strong hyung is, with that technique—】

The boy's voice vanished along with the vibration that spread immediately after.

「The entire world was trembling.」

[Great Mountain Push]. Initially a stigma that had only amounted to prying open locked subway doors.

「Across the 1,864th round and the 1,865th round, Lee Hyunsung had relentlessly trained this stigma.」

What did it mean to 'push'? Pushing and pushing again, Lee Hyunsung thought about what 'pushing' was.

「To push is, at the same time, to be pushed by it.」

As he firmly planted both legs into the ground, his stories churned.

「To push is to invade another existence's space, and through the felt resistance, to confirm that existence once more.」

Along with Lee Hyunsung's battle cry, the earth, the sky, and the surrounding universe were shaking violently.

「And so, 'to push' is.」

As if pushing the entire 'frame' of the space-time to which a matter belonged, the universe was being pushed away by Lee Hyunsung's strength.

「The act of completely colliding the history one has lived against the opponent.」

The World Serpent that wrapped around the world of the scenario writhed in agony.

Kugugugugu.

The history a man had collided with was pushing back a single ruin.

【If you do not give up.】

Lee Hyunsung's body, which had gradually grown in volume, looked as if he had lifted the 'World Serpent' in its entirety. He added with a true voice carrying terrifying ambition.

【I could throw you to the edge of the universe just like this.】

No one could deny that those words were the truth. That was how strong Lee Hyunsung was, and he possessed the power to realize his story.

It was then that a clicking sound was heard from somewhere.

【Load.】

A voice carrying a bone-chilling coolness.

【Fire.】

Subsequently, along with an explosion that blanketed the earth, a volley of fire poured toward Lee Hyunsung and Jung Heewon.

「Since when had it been there? A single battleship was floating in that place.」

The pale dust cleared, revealing the steel barrier Lee Hyunsung had created. Even though it was a light warning shot, a faint hairline crack had formed on the exterior of the barrier. It meant the existence that had poured out the attack just now was an Outer God possessing an equally powerful status.

【I knew this would happen.】

A voice carrying a sense of déjà vu. Jung Heewon felt her hands trembling. That 'World Serpent', and the Lee Hyunsung beside her. At her current level, they were opponents too daunting to handle. Yet another monster on that level had appeared before her eyes.

【I told you, didn't I? That in the end, it might turn out like this.】

Taking the melted sky as an ocean, a colossal battleship was floating as if suspended. Atop that battleship was a woman radiating an immense status. A ponytail fluttering pitch-black in the wind. Jung Heewon's eyes widened.

【Jihye-ya. Stand down. This time, even I cannot concede.】

When Lee Hyunsung warned first, Lee Jihye frowned.

【Hyunsung ahjussi. We have a conclusion we want.】

Spitting out the bubble gum she had been chewing, Lee Jihye spoke.

【And ahjussi has no right to stop us. Because—】

It was an ancient resentment. As if unraveling the end of long-harbored emotions, Lee Jihye, who had now grown from a girl into a warrior, grasped her Twin Dragon Swords.

【Because at the end of that story, you chose a 'conclusion' different from ours.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1066 Episode 67. The World Serpent (4)

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【Jihye-ya.】

Lee Hyunsung looked up at Lee Jihye with a hardened expression. In the eyes of the girl who had now become an adult, a cold resolve dwelled.

【I did not come to fight.】

【You came to stop us anyway. Then you should've been prepared to fight.】

Lee Jihye finished speaking with a frigid expression and promptly extended her right hand. At that, the cannons of her battleship reminiscent of a turtle ship—Turtle Dragon—aimed at the ground all at once.

【I'm not joking, ahjussi. If you don't back down now, I won't go easy on you.】

【Jihye-ya, I—】

【Load.】

The moment Lee Jihye's hand was about to move downward once more, a shadow wavering beside Lee Hyunsung entered her field of vision. Accompanied by slowly dilating pupils, Lee Jihye's voice trembled faintly.

【Heewon unnie?】

Jung Heewon, who had been awkwardly gripping her sword hilt beside Lee Hyunsung, also looked at her. The moment the two gazes met, memories rose.

「"Unnie!"」

Jung Heewon remembered Lee Jihye. Because in this world, she had fought alongside Lee Jihye several times. Yet the memories that surfaced were not just one.

「"Uh..... I'm a bit weak to cool unnies."」

Along with sparks of tzztzztzz, memories from a time she had never lived rose in her mind. Jung Heewon realized that this was a memory of the 1,864th round. A faintly welling dizziness and an emotion of yearning that densely filled her heart. Even though they were not her own emotions, Jung Heewon stumbled for a moment, intoxicated by that story.

After gazing at Jung Heewon for a moment, Lee Jihye slowly turned her head and asked.

【Doesn't seem to be the unnie I know. Where is Heewon unnie?】

Just by looking past Jung Heewon, Lee Jihye seemed to have noticed that she was not the Jung Heewon she remembered.

【Unnie chose that conclusion together with ahjussi, didn't she? So why is ahjussi alone? Where's unnie?】

【Heewon-ssi is.....】

【Well, whatever. It doesn't matter. Seems unnie had a bit of conscience left at least.】

At Lee Jihye's sharp tone, Lee Hyunsung let out a soft sigh.

「He knew that this was not Lee Jihye's true feelings.」

Though Lee Jihye was sometimes aggressive, she was not someone who would say such words to her companions. If she gave such a retort, there was only one reason.

【Go back even now. It is still not too late.】

No one here wanted to point swords at each other. They were once companions, and people who wanted to see the end of the same story. Even though the conclusion they

chose was different, perhaps even that conclusion ultimately originated from their feelings toward a single person.

[The influence of Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' grows stronger.]

Along with the churning of the Giant Story, flames flickered over Lee Jihye's eyes. Lee Jihye was not a Great Disaster like the 'World Serpent', but she had been summoned as a kind of guardian protecting that serpent.

「Giant of the Sea, Aegir.」

As her Twin Dragon Swords pointed to the ground, an ocean began to churn above the melted sky.

【Final warning. If you don't go back—】

The next moment, Jung Heewon's figure vanished. [Red Phoenix Shunpo] narrowing the distance in an instant. Startled, Lee Jihye countered with [Ghost Walk].

Accompanied by a sharp screeching friction, the two swords let out a violent cry. A strong story pressure felt in her grip. Lee Jihye opened her mouth in a voice mixed with pure admiration.

【What's this? How did you train to this extent in a mere 41st round?】

"A mere 41st round. I really want to stop hearing that."

【Why? I only said the truth.】

Instead of answering, Jung Heewon swung her sword. Watching that sword trajectory, Lee Jihye activated a skill as if intrigued.

[Ghost Slayer].

Brilliant ghostly flames bloomed in Lee Jihye's pupils. Jung Heewon countered with the same [Ghost Slayer]. If Lee Jihye's [Ghost Slayer] was a skill trained to its limit, Jung Heewon's [Ghost Slayer] was slightly different. Even if its proficiency fell short, it was because she had the attribute effect of 'Butcher of Madness'.

Kagagagak!

Receiving the synergy of the attribute effect, Jung Heewon's physical capabilities were on par with Lee Jihye's for a moment. After pure sword strikes collided several times,

the first to step back was Lee Jihye.

【You wield a sword this well? In a mere 41st round?】

Subsequently, Lee Jihye's Twin Dragon Swords changed their position. Lee Hyunsung, as well as Shin Yoosung and Lee Gilyoung watching the fierce battle from the firmament, recognized that technique of Lee Jihye's.

「Instant Kill (瞬殺)」

Lee Jihye's fatal technique that sent the heads of even the stars in that sky flying in a single strike.

【Jihye-ya! No!】

When Lee Hyunsung's roar echoed, her Twin Dragon Swords had already approached Jung Heewon's throat. A strike that could not be handled with reflexes. Almost instinctively, Jung Heewon swung her sword.

「Formless Sword Qi.」

Dozens of strands of Formless Sword Qi unleashed from her entire body subtly bent the sword tip of Instant Kill. Subsequently, her reflexes, reacting a beat late, barely dragged her body out from the domain of Instant Kill.

Spat.

Seeing Jung Heewon dodge the attack by a split-second interval, a smile bloomed on Lee Jihye's lips.

【You dodged it? Then how about this?】

A chain of strikes of [Instant Kill] unfolded. A barrage of blows that could not be dodged by mere luck alone. Gritting her teeth, Jung Heewon unleashed Formless Sword Qi to deflect the trajectory of [Instant Kill] somehow. Realizing the situation was turning urgent, as Lee Hyunsung ran over, Lee Jihye spread her left hand.

【Fire.】

At the bombardment pouring from the battleship, Lee Hyunsung could not dare approach, shouting Lee Jihye's name.

「This was the power of the 'Monarch of the Great Sea' who had seen the conclusion twice.」

The martial power to pin down Lee Hyunsung with bombardment and overwhelm the 41st round's Jung Heewon, who could compete with a Myth-grade Constellation.

【Not bad, 41st round's Heewon unnie.】

Yet the 41st round's Jung Heewon did not collapse easily either. She had a reason why she must not collapse. As if already knowing that reason, Lee Jihye changed her stance once more.

[Giant Story, 'Next City' begins its storytelling.]

The Giant Story possessed by Lee Jihye moved.

【Let's see you take this too.】

Blessed by the 'Giant Story', the cannon barrels of Turtle Dragon began to glow red.

【Unnie! No!】

Belatedly, Shin Yoosung moved the 'World Serpent'.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' continues its storytelling.]

However, bound by the Giant Story, the 'World Serpent' rejected her control. Not missing that opening, Lee Jihye's Twin Dragon Swords pointed at Jung Heewon.

【Fire.】

Pouring bombardment. In the distance, Lee Hyunsung, having used Steel Transformation, was rushing over, but the bombardment had already arrived right before Jung Heewon's eyes.

Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship. Secret Absolute Technique. Single Sword Cleaving the Sky.

Heavy sword gang cleaved the sky. Bombardment exploded like fireworks in the firmament. Yet even with the Secret Absolute Technique containing all her power, she could not block that bombardment. The sound of blood splashing and bones breaking. In an instant, her vision wavered, and one of Jung Heewon's knees buckled under the bombardment.

【Fire.】

As if attempting to utterly break Jung Heewon's will, Lee Jihye's second bombardment poured down. Jung Heewon unleashed Single Sword Cleaving the Sky once again. The sword gang had noticeably decreased in size. More than half of the bombardment was offset by the sword gang, but the remaining bombardment grazed past Jung Heewon's arms and legs.

"What is so proud about experiencing the scenarios twice?"

One step. And then another step. Jung Heewon continued to advance through the artillery fire.

"So what did you gain after seeing the end twice?"

As another round of bombardment passed, Jung Heewon noticed that sensation had vanished from her left shoulder.

【Fire.】

The third bombardment began. Now, the sword gang of Single Sword Cleaving the Sky did not even reach a few meters. Even so, her sword gang shone brightly amidst the thick artillery fire. In a voice as vivid as that sword gang, Jung Heewon spoke.

"All you're doing is coming all the way here to destroy someone else's worldline."

Was it because of the resentment dwelling in that vividness? In a somewhat agitated voice, Lee Jihye pushed back.

【You cannot speak so carelessly. We—】

Jung Heewon's other knee, which had been barely enduring, buckled as well.

【We merely—】

Toward Jung Heewon collapsing to the ground, Lee Jihye's final bombardment flew in.

【Unnie! No!】

Along with Shin Yoosung's voice, the 'World Serpent' burst into a cry. With an expression of 'ah', Lee Jihye hurriedly withdrew the Giant Story. But some of the bombardment had already reached Jung Heewon's proximity. Arriving at a razor-thin timing, Lee Hyunsung deployed Steel Transformation to take the brunt of the shelling.

Kugugugugu!

The moment Lee Jihye, barely catching her breath, was about to open her mouth again.

Crash!

A deafening roar that tore the eardrums was heard from behind. Looking back, explosive smoke was soaring from Lee Jihye's Turtle Dragon that had been dominating the firmament. It was not something Lee Hyunsung or Shin Yoosung had done. Shells flying from somewhere. Someone was pouring artillery fire toward Turtle Dragon.

【What bastard—】

"Unnie!"

A voice full of déjà vu heard from somewhere. Hurriedly swinging her Twin Dragon Swords to deflect the incoming artillery shells, Lee Jihye looked in that direction.

Kwakwakwakwakwa!

Though not as powerful as that of 'Turtle Dragon', it was nevertheless a bombardment of a sufficiently bothersome degree. Frowning, Lee Jihye released her status to clear the dust, and beyond the undulating night sky, she saw a fleet aimed toward this direction.

「There was a 'Ghost Fleet (幽靈艦隊)'.」

Lee Jihye's eyes slowly widened. Without a doubt, the Ghost Fleet. But it was not her Ghost Fleet.

「The Ghost Fleet of the 41st round.」

In the distant sky, a single battleship appearing in midair was seen dropping off two incarnations before vanishing. Familiar faces disembarking from the ship were running toward Jung Heewon.

"Unnie! We're here!"

「The 41st round's Lee Jihye and the 41st round's Shin Yoosung were there.」

Hurriedly supporting Jung Heewon, the two could be seen glaring this way and shouting.

"Did that person make unnie like this? I'll teach her a—"

The 41st round's Lee Jihye, who had not yet seen the end of the scenarios, glared this way with smoldering eyes. And a moment later, bewilderment surfaced in her pupils.

"Uh?"

Did she see the woman with a face identical to her own? The 41st round's Lee Jihye blankly opened her mouth.

Receiving that still-innocent gaze, the 1,864th round's Lee Jihye—the 'Monarch of the Great Sea'—tightly shut her eyes.

「In the ending shown by 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', there was no story like this.」

【That ahjussi really is cruel. Isn't he?】

The one who sent the 41st round's Lee Jihye and Shin Yoosung here was probably that 'Kim Dokja'. The Kim Dokja who had possessed Cheon Inho's face and briefly visited their world.

Opening her eyes again, she saw the figures of the 41st round's Lee Jihye, Shin Yoosung, and Jung Heewon still looking this way.

「Once, she was in that place. Together with companions.」

Memories surged like waves. The Great Disasters from the '999th round' that had appeared as the end of the world. To block them, she too had stood in that spot.

「And now, she had become a disaster raiding a worldline.」

Lee Jihye looked down at her palms. Atop those palms, the stories she had plundered to come all the way here opened their mouths as if shrieking.

「Outer God (外神).」

The term referring to evil gods existing outside the scenarios, plundering the stories of those who live the scenarios. Only then did Lee Jihye realize what she had become.

【Jihye-ya.】

Lee Hyunsung, who had raised his body from amidst the shelling, spoke.

【Our story already ended long ago.】

She had known that kind of thing from the start. And it was not words she wanted to hear from Lee Hyunsung's mouth.

【I know that too.】

Perhaps the 41st round's Jung Heewon was right. She was merely a 'disaster' to this worldline. Whatever circumstances she had, whatever tragedy she had experienced, from the perspective of this world, it was none of their concern.

【But Dokja ahjussi said it.】

Even so, she had come all the way here.

That story written by Han Sooyoung, lived by Yoo Joonghyuk, and read by Kim Dokja—she too had read it as she came here.

【That all we have to do is read it 'again'. If you read it again and again, sometimes the story changes.】

Slowly curling her hands into fists, Lee Jihye spoke.

【So there is only one way for you all to win in this fight.】

She was a disaster of this worldline. Her purpose was to destroy this world and seize the 'conclusion' granted to it.

【Kill me, and try to take this story from me.】

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1067 Episode 67. The World Serpent (5)

This world is composed of Kim Dokja's lies.

「"You want me to drink this tea?"」

When she first heard that proposal from 'Snowfield Kim Dokja', Lee Jihye had asked sharply.

「"What on earth is your intention? Putting us in coffins, and what is this tea?"」

Probably not only her, but most of <Kim Dokja Company> would have felt similar emotions. However, even if feeling the same emotion, they would have all shown different reactions. Some would have gotten angry at such a Kim Dokja, and others would have silently watched him.

And some,

「"There, satisfied?"」

Would have drunk the tea in a single gulp, like her.

「"What happens to me now? Do I die?"」

To Lee Jihye asking with a smile, Snowfield Kim Dokja shook his head.

「"It's just coarse green tea that I like."」

「"What?"」

「"I offered it so you could rest a bit."」

The moment she heard those words, Lee Jihye was swept by a deep sense of lethargy and collapsed onto the chair.

「"You know, don't you? Even if ahjussi put something in this tea, we'd have no choice but to drink it."」

Kim Dokja did not answer. Even that silence was quintessentially Kim Dokja.

「"Ahjussi really is 'the Kim Dokja from back then', right?"」

The Kim Dokja from back then. The '49% Kim Dokja' who lived in the world after the conclusion together with them, even if only briefly. Snowfield Kim Dokja answered.

「"A part of me is."」

An ambiguous answer as always. Narrowing her eyes, Lee Jihye asked.

「"What on earth do you want, ahjussi?"」

「"You have already seen the conclusion I want."」

Startled by those words, Lee Jihye's hand holding the teacup trembled faintly.

「"Is that really the 'conclusion'?"」

Perhaps because she had seen that conclusion, she was here now. Clinging to a thread of hope at that single scene. Yet Kim Dokja, who had handed her that thread of hope, wore a rather frigid expression.

「"Yes. You will eventually reach that story."」

The inside of the room was endlessly quiet, but the inside of Lee Jihye was chaotic. Calming the swirling emotions, Lee Jihye bit her lip tightly and asked.

「"The price of that conclusion?"」

Snowfield Kim Dokja looked down at the empty teacup she had set down. Stories swirled atop the teacup, soon forming a miniature landscape.

Lee Jihye looked down at that landscape as well. The characters of the 41st round. The world they lived in was there.

「A world different from the landscape she knew.」

And now, she was seeing the vivid landscape that had been reflected inside that teacup right before her eyes.

【Come at me. Prove your stories.】

Watching the bombardment of the Ghost Fleet pouring down, Lee Jihye swung her Twin Dragon Swords. As if confronting the landscape before her eyes, she too swung her swords to protect her own landscape.

On the front line of the landscape she knew, Yoo Joonghyuk was always there.

There was Han Sooyoung always pointing her finger at him, Jung Heewon shaking her head while watching them, and Lee Hyunsung wearing a faint smile. There was Yoo Sangah giving gentle advice, and Lee Seolhwa always anxious that her companions might get hurt. Lowering her gaze slightly, Lee Gilyoung and Shin Yoosung could be seen bickering as well.

People who could be called peculiar if peculiar, strange if strange, and ordinary if ordinary. Lee Jihye was together with them.

Now, it was all a story like a lie.

「She had definitely lived inside that sweet lie created by Kim Dokja.」

And now, before her eyes was another lie of Kim Dokja. The characters of the 41st round. The three people standing while supporting each other against the disaster trying to destroy their world. Perhaps Lee Jihye resented Kim Dokja a little.

【Why did ahjussi have to continue the story.】

As if asking Kim Dokja, she questioned the landscape before her eyes.

【Why—】

The answer returned with sharp blades. The history they had lived was answering her.

[Story, 'Butcher of Madness' continues its storytelling!]

Those were 'different answers' to the stories she had experienced.

[Story, 'Survivor of Chungmuro' continues its storytelling!]

Another possibility that all the history they had lived could have reached.

[Story, 'Savior of Murim' continues its storytelling!]

Therefore, in truth, she knew without needing to hear an answer.

「Kim Dokja is a being who loved stories more than anyone in this universe.」

That god, who could not favor merely a single story because he loved all stories, must have ultimately cherished the characters of all other worldlines—the 'Lee Jihye' and 'Jung Heewon' of this world as well.

"Unnie! Run!"

As the 41st round's Lee Jihye poured out bombardment, Lee Jihye's defense wavered for a moment. Not missing that gap, Jung Heewon penetrated her distance.

「That blade is the proof that Kim Dokja loved this world.」

Where on earth did such power still remain? Parrying Jung Heewon's sword that exploded heavily, Lee Jihye thought of Kim Dokja once again.

「He was a person who lived to see the conclusion of the story he loved.」

During the '73rd Demon King', and when 'The Nameless Mist' appeared in the Demon Realm. Each time, Kim Dokja sacrificed himself to continue the stories.

Within her vision undulating as if drunk, Lee Jihye felt for the first time that she might understand the Kim Dokja of back then.

「"Lee Jihye! Remember who you were!"」

An ancient story surged, and a stage wavered beside her. The figure of Kim Dokja holding a white flag beside her, desperately trying to persuade the '999th round's Lee Jihye', was drawn like a hallucination.

「"Do not destroy this 'worldline'! This place is the same as the world you lived in! Yoo Joonghyuk is here, Lee Hyunsung is here, and Lee Jihye is here!"」

Those words from back then now returned to her of today.

【I know too, ahjussi.】

She was no longer the 'Wounded Sword Demon' alone. The seventeen-year-old girl who embraced only her own wounds and looked at the world through the cracks of those wounds was gone now.

「She had now reached the age where she could understand Kim Dokja.」

The Wounded Sword Demon had now become a person who could read other people's wounds beyond her own.

「It was thanks to the story he gave.」

Because of that, because she understood such a Kim Dokja, Lee Jihye—

「Felt for the first time that at the end of this story, the time had come to let him go.」

A new 'stage' was unfolding atop the stage of 'Ragnarok'. A thick scent of the sea. The 'stage' where <Kim Dokja Company> had confronted the disaster of the 999th round.

【Good, keep going.】

Under Jung Heewon's sword strikes driving in desperately, wounds were increasing on Lee Jihye's entire body as well before she knew it. How did the end of this story go? A story she had reminisced hundreds, thousands of times. A story she had reread several times in the version written by Han Sooyoung.

Yet why was it, strangely, at this moment, Lee Jihye could not remember the conclusion of this 'stage' very well. What happened to her 999th round self? Was it because the tea Snowfield Kim Dokja gave was too bitter, or because she lost a portion of her stories while crossing over to this worldline? The memory would not easily surface.

Lee Jihye saw Jung Heewon's sword flying toward her. A story shining purely, attained through earnest, repeated training. If she met her end by being struck by such a desperate sword, that too wouldn't be bad.

「And all stories move along the blank spaces.」

And so, the moment the blade of the realized stage was about to reach her heart.

"Do it properly."

Jung Heewon, who had stopped her sword, growled.

[Incarnation 'Jung Heewon' rejects the blessing of 'Stage Transformation'!]

Astonishingly, the blessing of the 'stage' was vanishing from Jung Heewon's entire body.

"I don't need a 'stage' like this."

As if casting away the role clinging to her, Jung Heewon shouted.

"Just as you said, my world is for me to prove. Even if I fail, even if I'm broken, even if the conclusion is already decided—this is 'my story'."

Blankly, Lee Jihye stared at that Jung Heewon.

「Perhaps what is needed to confront a god is not a grandiose story.」

She didn't want to admit it. Yet this time, she had no choice but to admit it.

「Over the 41st round's Jung Heewon swinging her sword, the figure of Kim Dokja overlapped.」

This world had the qualification to receive Kim Dokja's choice. At the center of the pitch-black night sky, several stars twinkled. Even amidst the ruins, stars that had not given up on the story were watching this story.

「This was the reason Kim Dokja could fight the masters of those great mythologies.」

This world loves a protagonist who struggles while betting their everything. Starlight granted to the 'protagonist' who ultimately does not give up on the story even amidst scheduled destruction.

【Right.】

Why does this world show hope only at the moment one lays down the answer?

【Now I can see it too.】

Watching the incoming sword strike, Lee Jihye,

「Only now could she finally see the disappeared Kim Dokja.」

Everywhere in the scenarios was the Kim Dokja she had liked. In Jung Heewon's sword, in the shouts of the 41st round's Shin Yoosung and Lee Jihye, in Lee Hyunsung's hands, in the cries of the writhing World Serpent, in the handful of starlight still illuminating this night sky—Kim Dokja was in all of them.

Oooooooo!

As if reacting to the stories of the two people, the World Serpent burst into a roar.

[Instant Kill].

As if drawing the final stroke of the story, Lee Jihye drew her sword. Embedding all her stories, she swung her sword as if making this world remember her. That was Lee Jihye's own story. Neither a Giant Story nor anything else, but merely the total sum of the history lived by the human 'Lee Jihye'.

Toward that Lee Jihye, Jung Heewon swung her sword as well.

「The 41st round and the 1,864th round collided.」

In the extreme split-second, the sound of worlds overlapping was heard.

「Thus, only a single incarnation with an unyielding will shall obtain the sword that will change fate.」

That was a story that did not exist in the original 'Ragnarok'. A shred of blessing toward an incarnation who confronted a god purely with the power of a human.

[Item, 'Mikazuki Munechika' gains a new possibility!]

An item that had been an A-grade replica. The sword of Jung Heewon, which had severed incarnations, severed monsters, and even severed stars, was blooming upon receiving Jung Heewon's stories. The symbol of a story holding starlight—a Star Relic (星遺物).

[Star Relic, 'Sword That Protects the Epilogue' has been born!]

Jung Heewon gripped her new sword with both hands and slashed horizontally.

[Exclusive skill, 'Time of Judgment' has been activated.]

As the skill possessed solely by Jung Heewon in this world radiated light.

[A single star has consented to the activation of 'Time of Judgment'.]

A single star assisted that probability.

'Uriel.'

Lee Jihye saw the archangel wings sprouting from Jung Heewon's shoulder blades.

'You were reading all along as well.'

Lee Jihye saw the sword flying toward her. [Instant Kill] was fast, but Jung Heewon's sword was a bit faster. Lee Jihye slowly blinked her eyes.

「I'm dying.」

Yet the moment Jung Heewon's sword was about to penetrate her heart, the sword tip abruptly bent its trajectory. The tip aiming for her heart accurately struck Lee Jihye's sword hilt.

Pachichit!

And almost at the same time, Lee Jihye's [Instant Kill] grazed past Jung Heewon's forearm.

【Ah.】

Lee Jihye watched her Twin Dragon Swords flying away emptily. A truly perfect sword path. Even without using Giant Stories or the power of an Outer God—

「The Jung Heewon before her eyes had surpassed her, who had seen the conclusion twice, purely with swordsmanship alone.」

Still scattering transcendental energy waves, Jung Heewon was catching her breath as if about to collapse, oblivious to the stories pouring from her entire body.

"Heewon unnie!"

Subsequently, the 41st round's Shin Yoosung appearing from somewhere grabbed Jung Heewon's hand. As if agreed upon, the two mounted the 3rd-grade monster species 'Wyvern King' and soared into the sky above.

Their objective was clear. They were soaring toward the 'World Serpent'. Unable to chase after that Jung Heewon, Lee Jihye blankly looked up. Then, something suddenly came to mind.

Kugugugugu.

The stories of 'Ragnarok' were churning. Lee Jihye looked at the droplets of Jung Heewon's blood smeared on the back of her hand. In those blood droplets, a story she knew well was contained.

「Thor's story.」

Why was it? The story of the dead Thor was seeping out from Jung Heewon's stories. Suddenly, the lore of 'Ragnarok' flashed through Lee Jihye's mind.

「In the end, the 'World Serpent' will be killed by 'Thor'.」

The moment Lee Jihye, rising while staggering, was about to take flight into the air again.

【Jihye-ya.】

Lee Hyunsung, appearing from behind, held her shoulder.

【Let go, ahjussi.】

【Trust in Heewon-ssi.】

To trust someone. Hearing those sweet yet anxious words, Lee Jihye felt her resolve weakening continuously.

【Even the Heewon-ssi we do not know is still Heewon-ssi.】

Raising her head once more, Lee Jihye looked up at the two people vanishing toward the World Serpent. A story nearing its conclusion mobilizes all its capabilities to realize that epilogue. Gazing at the scenery flowing toward an unstoppable conclusion, Lee Jihye imagined once more that 'Kim Dokja's lie' she had so longed to see.

「She already knows the end of this story.」

Was Kim Dokja still reading this story?

【Ahjussi, I did my best.】

Now, that was the only thing to lean on. That he would still be reading this story. So that at the end of this stage radiant with tragedy—

【Yes, Dokja-ssi will know as well.】

Still, hoping an epilogue they had not yet read remained.

[The final stars of the <Star Stream> begin their storytelling.]

The eastern sky could be seen brightening brilliantly as if the sun were rising. Both Lee Hyunsung and Lee Jihye looked at that sky. Stars shining as if filling the empty darkness. The starlight pouring here and there looked like endlessly falling snow. The final stage of this story illuminated by that starlight.

「In a place far away, a snowfield was opening.」

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# 1068 Episode 67. The World Serpent (6)

Jung Heewon looked up at the endless sky road. Even with the acceleration of the 'Wyvern King' moving at sonic speed, the head of the World Serpent was still nowhere in sight.

"Unnie, are you alright?"

At Shin Yoosung's worried inquiry, Jung Heewon forced herself to nod.

"I'm fine."

She was not fine. Jung Heewon was well aware of her own condition.

「She had fought by exploding all of her stories.」

In Jung Heewon's pupils where the Ring of Chaos had surfaced, a strange light was gleaming. This was the secret art of [Breaking the Sky Swordsmanship] she had created.

「Mad Sky (狂天)」

It was a technique that drew out energy several times her inherent potential by condensing and exploding all her stories in a single instant. The story veins throughout her entire body were shattered, and the overflowing stories were eating away at her life

in real-time. Currently, she was somehow maintaining consciousness by sustaining the explosive flow of stories, but it would not be for very long.

「Once this flow of stories was cut, she would die or become a cripple.」

It was a technique she had saved all along to use in the final decisive battle, but to face the 1,864th round's Lee Jihye, there was no other choice. The pain of her flesh burning from the fiery stories. If the attribute effect of 'Butcher of Madness' had not attenuated the pain, Jung Heewon would have lost her senses long ago. Even now, stories that had broken free from her story veins were running wild throughout her entire body in real-time.

Yet what frustrated her more than such pain was that even after using her cherished [Mad Sky], she could not achieve a particularly satisfying match.

—You know, right? If that kid had gone all out, you wouldn't have won.

A voice echoing in her mind as if waiting. It was the voice of the 1,864th round's Jung Heewon.

'I know.'

Jung Heewon recalled the 1,864th round's Lee Jihye. Strong and dazzling stories. Swordsmanship that reached its pinnacle by completing two endings. If Lee Jihye had used even a portion of her 'Giant Story', the one who lost would have been this side. Lee Jihye was that strong, and Jung Heewon had no choice but to acknowledge their stories.

「They lived a history that could not be broken by anything.」

Paradoxically, because she had endured such history, Lee Jihye could not kill Jung Heewon. For beautiful and powerful stories hold equally noble convictions.

'I didn't want to receive something like sympathy.'

—It's not sympathy. Jihye merely acknowledged your story.

Acknowledgment handed over from an entirely different worldline. It was a difficult emotion, but Jung Heewon also faintly sensed what kind of feeling that was. Because at the final moment of collision, Jung Heewon too had caught the shadow of a familiar man in Lee Jihye's stories.

The man she had so desperately wanted to protect. The story of that man existed in the stories of the other worldline as well.

「That was why Jung Heewon could not cut down Lee Jihye.」

Even while knowing Lee Jihye was a disaster who had come to destroy this world, even while knowing well that if she did not strike her down this worldline could perish, in the end, she could not cut her down.

"Over there!"

Along with Shin Yoosung's shout, the summit of the World Serpent was visible in the distance. Above the dizzying night sky, the enormous, translucent head of the World Serpent hung suspended. The World Serpent was in a deep slumber as if hypnotized. And atop that head, a young man and woman were seated. They too kept their eyes closed as if communing with the World Serpent.

Dismounting from the 'Wyvern King', Jung Heewon looked up at the World Serpent.

「Is that truly the 'Great Disaster'?」

It felt strange. Despite being an overwhelmingly scaled disaster, they did not feel like a disaster at all. Perhaps it was because of the stories of the 1,864th round she had encountered earlier.

Drawing in light breaths repeatedly, Jung Heewon gripped her sword hilt. It was something that had to be done. No matter who they were, it didn't matter. Even if she could not cut down the 1,864th round's Lee Jihye, she could not simply pass by this 'World Serpent' all the same.

[Story, 'Courage of the Thunder of Thursday' begins its storytelling!]

The relic received from Odin before coming here shone brightly in her bosom.

「[It will be of help in confronting the disaster.]」

Thor's story. The blessing of the Constellation who had perished together while confronting that World Serpent was with her. Yet strangely, Thor's story did not embolden her. Rather, at the moment she faced the World Serpent, what came to her mind was Lee Jihye's voice.

「【Right, now I can see it too.】」

Jung Heewon did not know what the landscape she claimed to have seen was. Even so, at that moment, Jung Heewon was undoubtedly connected to another worldline for an instant. A tragedy that did not guarantee a conclusion. The moment two worldlines

standing at the forefront of different tragedies met, Jung Heewon suddenly arrived before a certain question.

「Why do 'stories' exist in this world, and what are we searching for at the end of this empty tragedy?」

A question faced by the stars standing before their own ■■. She too stood here right now to answer that question.

It was then that a portion of the pitch-black sky rippled.

【Hmph, you have already reached this far? Dealing with the 'Monarch of the Great Sea' couldn't have been easy...】

Demonic qi blanketing the sky. Jung Heewon knew who he was. He was one of this world's Great Recorders.

【Surprisingly, it seems things might truly go according to that person's thoughts.】

Confirming that presence, the 1,864th round's Jung Heewon muttered as if grinding her teeth.

—Asmodeus.

Judging by his tone, he had no intention of stepping aside obediently.

「The 'Demon King of the Cinema' had sided with 'Snow White'.」

From this side's perspective, it was unwelcome news. Just facing the 'World Serpent' alone was daunting, yet a Great Recorder had turned into an enemy as well.

"Unnie, I—"

"Step back."

He was not an opponent the 41st round's Shin Yoosung could contend with. Therefore, she had to do it. While even a shred of [Mad Sky]'s effect remained, even if she had to melt this entire body, she had to kill that Recorder and slay the World Serpent.

Yet at that moment.

—I have a favor.

The 1,864th round's Jung Heewon spoke.

—Save those children.

Save the children? Reflexively, Jung Heewon looked up at the head of the World Serpent. There were still a young man and woman communing with the 'World Serpent'. She could tell instinctively. The 'children' she spoke of were them.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' continues its storytelling!]

Blessed by the Giant Story, the serpent's head shone brilliantly.

[Great Disaster, 'World Serpent' prepares 'Planet Shattering'!]

Planet Shattering. If that serpent was left as it was, what would happen was self-evident. Yet her other self, even after seeing such a catastrophe, was saying strange words.

—With who you are now, you can do it.

Without hearing any explanation, the moment Jung Heewon heard those words, she realized what her 1,864th round self wanted from her.

「Across all these rounds, the realm reached solely by the Jung Heewon of the 41st round.」

Intent-Formed Sword (意形劍).

「The essence of the Intent-Formed Sword is the power to sever given fate.」

In short, the 1,864th round's Jung Heewon was pleading with her right now.

—Sever those children's [Fate].

As the power of [Intent-Formed Sword] dwelled in her hands, the trajectory of [Fate] became visible to Jung Heewon's eyes as well. Endlessly dense records engraved. She could see 'Asmodeus' who oversaw those records, and the context of the Giant Story wrapping around him.

'I cannot use [Intent-Formed Sword] right now. This power is—'

The [Intent-Formed Sword] that severs [Fate] cannot be used recklessly. This power had another place where it must be used. Even so, the 1,864th round's Jung Heewon was earnest.

—Please.

After a brief pause, Jung Heewon asked.

'Did you teach me [Intent-Formed Sword] from the beginning just to ask me this?'

—Yes, that's right.

Jung Heewon let out a soft breath. Repaying what was received. That was her iron rule.

'But I can't face the Recorder while using [Intent-Formed Sword].'

—Don't worry about that.

And the next moment, Jung Heewon felt a pain as if her entire back were being torn off. Even with the attribute of 'Butcher of Madness' active, an indescribable agony set in. A sensation as if another life were pupating from within her. And the next moment, along with a sound like tearing film, something surged out from her. Emitting an endlessly dazzling brilliance, it floated up and soon stood by Jung Heewon's side.

【Ho-oh.】

There stood another Jung Heewon, looking identical to Jung Heewon herself.

「She is the Jung Heewon of the 1,864th round.」

The 'Judge of Destruction' who had chosen another path of judgment from her.

【A remarkable authority. An 'artificial body' made purely of stories.】

Asmodeus's eyes glinted white.

【But do you think you can face me with such a toy?】

【Go. Save the children.】

The moment the 1,864th round's Jung Heewon unleashed her status, Jung Heewon also kicked off the ground.

Oooooooo!

As if trying to block her approach, the World Serpent let out a rough roar. But just like when she first confronted the serpent, no malice toward her could be felt from the

serpent.

「The heart that did not want to harm.」

Clearly, this serpent and those 'children' had no intention of being hostile toward her.

「Shin Yoosung, we have to.」

「We can't.」

Children's voices heard hummingly.

「We have to do this. That way... he will return! ...Otherwise—」

Hearing that voice, Jung Heewon gripped the 'Sword That Protects the Epilogue' with both hands. Atop that blade, Jung Heewon's [Intent-Formed Sword] dwelled.

「Sever 'Fate'.」

She had no confidence. The skein of [Fate] surrounding them was so thick and dense that even daring to bring a blade close felt as if it would not be permitted.

[Giant Story, 'Ragnarok' glares at you.]

As if noticing her will, the Giant Story reacted to her. A single world was looking down upon her. As if questioning how a mere thing like her could dare interfere with this stage, the records of the story seized the stage.

「Thus 'Thor' and the 'World Serpent' met.」

An ordinary incarnation would have been dominated by those records and sacrificed themselves to realize the story. But Jung Heewon, who had used [Mad Sky], could temporarily defy the domination of the Giant Story.

「Just as no story can be heard by the ears of a madman.」

Her body, reaching its limit, wavered as if about to shatter. The remaining time of [Mad Sky] was now less than a single minute. The opportunity would probably be only once.

「Can a single human resist fate?」

The Transcendent who had first created the Intent-Formed Sword had posed such a question.

「This is the answer of a human confronting the story called 'Fate'.」

The moment the World Serpent roared, Jung Heewon's [Intent-Formed Sword] moved.

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I gazed for a moment at the starlight twinkling in the distant sky. Probably around now, the final showdown with the 'World Serpent' was taking place.

Beside me, the Mass Production Maker, watching the same landscape together, spoke.

[You made an unexpected decision. I thought you would go yourself.]

"What happened to Lee Jihye and Shin Yoosung?"

[Transported via battleship. But those children alone won't be enough, will they?]

I was the one who deployed the 41st round's Lee Jihye and Shin Yoosung to that battlefield. Naturally, it was to see even a little effect of the 'stage'.

"It will be fine. I sent dependable reinforcements as well."

Just before using [Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint], I had asked the Third Kim Dokja to convey a short message to '1,864th round Lee Hyunsung'. Probably by now, he had also arrived at that battlefield. If it was him, I could trust him. And if Lee Hyunsung stepped forward, the 1,864th round's Jung Heewon wouldn't stay still either.

Somehow it had turned into a family feud among <Kim Dokja Company>, but even so, that was the best option right now. Because the only ones who could stop monsters like <Kim Dokja Company> was <Kim Dokja Company> themselves.

[Do you think the Mad Sword Emperor can stand against a Great Disaster?]

"The current Heewon-ssi will be able to."

The 41st round's Jung Heewon was the person with the most outstanding talent among the 'Jung Heewons' I knew. If it was her, who had lived a history different from other rounds, she might truly be able to accomplish something no one else could on that battlefield. Right now, there was nothing I could do other than believe so.

[They are coming.]

Along with the Handsome Monkey King's true voice, a colossal wave of disaster began to surge from the front. The wave of disaster approaching right before our eyes was

utterly catastrophic.

「No great star would dare block the front of that army.」

As if leading them, extinguishing all nearby Constellations, a Great Disaster was approaching.

【O o o o o o o o o o o o o o】

It was the anomalous form of Emperor. And behind him, I saw my brother walking forward.

「It felt as if a pure white snowfield that would erase everything was sweeping toward this place.」

Along the path where my brother walked, the stars he broke turned to ash and fluttered like snow.

「Whoever saw that landscape could not take their eyes off that existence.」

The closer my brother got, the louder my heartbeat pounded. Clearly, I had lived my best to reach this place. I thought I had grown strong enough to contend with any Myth-grade Constellation.

Yet the moment I saw the figure of my brother walking atop the pure white snowfield over there right now, a bizarre sensation came over me. Because right now, the brother over there truly—

「Looked like the 'Oldest Dream' of this story.」

Overwhelmed by that landscape, the Mass Production Maker asked once more.

[Do you really believe you can win?]

To say it again, the me of the past would not have been able to answer that question. No matter what stories I built, no matter what hardships I overcame to reach this place, I wouldn't have been able to guarantee that I could dare confront such an existence and emerge victorious.

"Yes."

Yet even so, I answered like that. It was neither an answer to overcome tension, nor stubbornness to drive away despair. Even after facing the true body of such an

overwhelming brother, my heart was strangely peaceful.

"I can win."

Perhaps that was.

[You have collected almost all of the 'Losses' scattered across this world.]

Proof that I too, at least in terms of 'status', had reached the same eye-level as my brother.

[Story, 'Successor of the Eternal Name' roars toward the battlefield!]

Subsequently, the stars illuminating us in the firmament became visible. Constellations illuminating the battlefield while radiating blindingly bright light. The Constellations of the Round Table, who had been hiding somewhere on this battlefield, were finally shining upon the final chapter of this story.

「Thus, all the stars in the universe gazed upon a single battlefield.」

Now, it was time to record the final chapter of this world.

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Author's Note

Hello, this is Sing Shong.

Before we knew it, the side story has reached chapter 516.

At this point where really only the final chapter and epilogue remain, deeply apologetically, we will be entering a temporary hiatus.

The final chapter and the stories after it have already been decided, and we have sprinted until now for that conclusion, but as it is the final episode across all of Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint, our desire to inspect every story from beginning to end and meet readers with sufficient completeness came first.

We only have gratitude for everyone who stayed with this lacking author. Especially while writing the side story, very difficult personal circumstances overlapped, causing many moments of wavering throughout writing. The reason we were able to not give up on the story was because there were readers who loved this story.

The hiatus is scheduled to last about two months, and if we return sooner, we will make an announcement in advance.

We will do our best until the very end. Thank you as always for loving Omniscient Reader's Viewpoint.

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**[CLICK TO READ CHAPTER COMMENTS]**

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# To Be Continued

This is still being serialised.

**You can read the latest chapters here!**

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Thank you for reading.